The Apostolic Bible

Complete English Edition

87 books

Father Michael

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Genesis

Chapter 1

1 In the beginning, God made the heaven and the earth.

2 But the earth was invisible and unprepared, and darkness was over the abyss, and the Spirit of God was moving over the water.

3 And God said: Let light come to be, and light came to be.

4 And God saw the light, that it was good: and God separated the light from the darkness.

5 And God called the light day, and he called the darkness night. Evening and morning happened: Day One.

6 And God said: Let there come to be a firmament in the midst of the water, and let it divide water from water: and it happened this way.

7 And God made the firmament, and God divided the water which was below the firmament from the water which was above the firmament.

8 And God called the firmament heaven, and God saw that it was good. Evening and morning happened: The Second Day.

9 And God said: Let the water beneath the heaven be gathered into one gathering, and let dry land appear, and the water beneath the heaven was gathered together into their gatherings, and the dry land appeared.

10 And God called the dry land earth, and he called the gatherings of the waters the seas. And God saw that it was good.

11 And God said: Let the earth bring forth vegetation: plants with seeds of the same kind of plant, and fruit trees with fruit containing seeds of the same kind of tree on the earth: and it happened this way.

12 And the earth grew plants: plants that produce seeds of the same kind of plant, and fruit-growing trees that produce fruit containing seeds of the same kind of fruit tree on the earth: And God saw that it was good.

13 And evening and morning happened: the Third Day.

14 And God said let there come to be lights in the firmament of heaven, for the illumination of the earth: For the distinguishing of the middle of the day from the middle of the night. And let them be for signs, seasons, days, and years.

15 And let them be for illumination in the firmament of heaven, so as to shine upon the earth: and it happened this way.

16 And God made the stars and two great lights, the greater for ruling the day, and the lesser for ruling the night.

17 And God placed them in the firmament of heaven so as to shine upon the earth.

18 To rule the day and the night, and to separate light from darkness. And God saw that it was good.

19 And evening and morning happened: The Fourth Day.

20 And God said: let the waters bring forth crawling creatures with souls, and living flying creatures that fly over the earth along the firmament of the heaven. And it happened this way.

21 And God made the large sea creatures: Every kind of living and creeping creature that the waters brought forth, and every kind of flying creature: And God saw that it was good.

22 And God blessed them, saying: Increase, multiply, and fill the waters in the seas. And let the flying creatures multiply upon the earth.

23 And evening and morning happened: The Fifth Day.

24 And God said: let the earth bring forth living creatures with souls: four footed creatures, creeping creatures, and wild animals each according to their own kind: and it happened this way.

25 And God made the wild animals of the earth according to their kind, and the livestock according to their kind, and all the creatures that crawl on the earth according to their kind. And God saw that it was good.

26 And God said: let us make man according to our image and according to our likeness, and let them rule the fish of the sea, the flying creatures of the sky, the livestock, and all the creatures that crawl upon the earth.

27 And God made the man in the image of God: he made them male and female.

28 And God blessed them, saying: Increase, multiply, and fill the earth. Rule over it, and rule the fish of the sea, and the flying creatures in the sky, and all the livestock, and every creature that crawls on the earth.

29 And God said: Behold, I have given you every seed producing plant on earth, and every fruit tree that grows fruits containing seeds as food for you.

30 And to all the wild animals on earth, and to all the flying creatures in the sky, and to every creature that crawls on earth that has a soul, I have given every green plant as food. And it happened this way.

31 And God beheld that all of the things he had made were exceedingly good. And evening and morning happened: The Sixth Day.

Chapter 2

1 And the heaven and the earth were finished, and the whole cosmos of them.

2 And on the Sixth Day God finished the works which he made, and he rested on the Seventh Day from all the works which he made.

3 And God blessed the Seventh Day and sanctified it, because in it God ceased from all his works that he began to do.

4 This is the book of the genesis of heaven and earth, when they were made, the day God made the heaven and the earth,

5 And every green plant of the field before growing on the earth, and every plant of the field before it sprang up, for God had not yet caused it to rain upon the earth, and there was no man to cultivate the earth.

6 But a spring was flowing up from the earth and watering the whole face of the earth.

7 And God formed the man from the dust of the earth, and breathed onto his face the breath of life, and the man became a living soul.

8 And towards the east the Lord God planted a paradise in Eden, and placed the man he had made there.

9 And God caused every tree beautiful to behold and good for food to spring up from the earth, and the tree of life in the middle of paradise, and the tree of knowing knowledge of good and evil.

10 And a river flows from Eden to water the paradise; thence it is divided into four heads.

11 The name of one is Phison, this is the one which encircles all the land of Evilat, where there is gold.

12 And the gold of that land is good, and there is carbuncle and green stone.

13 And the name of the second river is Geon, this one encircles all of the land of Ethiopia.

14 And the third river is the Tigris, this one flows across from the Assyrians. And the fourth river is the Euphrates.

15 And the Lord God took the man that he made, and placed him in paradise to cultivate it and to guard it.

16 And the Lord God commanded Adam, saying, you shall eat from every tree in paradise.

17 But you shall not eat from the tree of knowing good and evil, and whatever day you eat from it, you shall die the death.

18 And the Lord God said: it is not good for the man to be alone, let us make a suitable helper for him.

19 And God formed all the beasts of the field and birds of heaven from the earth, and brought them to Adam to see what he would call them, and every living soul was named whatever Adam called it.

20 And Adam called names for all the cattle and for all the flying creatures of heaven and for all the beasts of the field, but for Adam no helper like him was found. –

21 And God cast a trance upon Adam, and put him to sleep; and he took one of his sides and filled up flesh in its place.

22 And the Lord God built the side, which he took from Adam, into a woman and brought her to Adam.

23 And Adam said: This now is bone from my bones and flesh from my flesh; she shall be called Woman, because she was taken from her man.

24 Because of this, a man will leave his father and his mother and will be joined to his woman, and the two will be one flesh.

25 And the two were naked, both Adam and his woman, and they were not ashamed.

Chapter 3

1 But the serpent was the most discerning of all the beasts upon the earth, which the Lord God made; and the serpent said to the woman: Why is it that God said: You shall certainly not eat from every tree that is in the paradise?

2 And the woman said to the serpent: From fruit of a tree of the paradise we shall eat,

3 but from fruit of the tree which is in the middle of the paradise, God said: You shall not eat from it, nor shall you touch it at all, lest you die.

4 And the serpent said to the woman: You shall not die the death;

5 for God knew that on whatever day you eat from it, your eyes will be opened, and you will be as gods, knowing good and evil.

6 And the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was pleasing for the eyes to see, and it was beautiful for understanding; and having taken from its fruit, she ate. And she also gave to her man with her, and they ate.

7 And the eyes of the two were opened, and they knew that they were naked, and they sewed leaves of a fig tree and made girdles for themselves.

8 And they heard the voice of the Lord God walking in the paradise toward evening, and both Adam and his woman hid themselves from the face of the Lord God in the midst of the tree of the paradise.

9 And the Lord God called Adam and said to him: Adam, where are you?

10 And he said to him: I heard your voice while you were walking in the paradise, and I was afraid, because I am naked, and I hid myself.

11 And he said to him: Who announced to you that you are naked? Did you eat from the tree of which I commanded you—this alone—not to eat from it?

12 And Adam said: The woman whom you gave with me, she gave me from the tree, and I ate.

13 And the Lord God said to the woman: What is this you did? And the woman said: The serpent deceived me, and I ate.

14 And the Lord God said to the serpent: Because you did this, accursed are you from all the cattle and from all the beasts of the earth; upon your breast and your belly you shall go, and earth you shall eat all the days of your life.

15 And I will set enmity between you and between the woman, and between your seed and between her seed; he will watch your head, and you will watch his heel.

16 And to the woman he said: Multiplying, I will multiply your sorrows and your groaning; in sorrows you shall bear children. And your turning will be toward your man, and he will rule over you.

17 But to Adam he said: Because you listened to the voice of your woman and ate from the tree of which I commanded you—this alone—not to eat from it, accursed is the earth in your works; in sorrows you shall eat it all the days of your life.

18 It will cause thorns and thistles to spring up for you, and you shall eat the grass of the field.

19 In the sweat of your face you shall eat your bread until your returning to the earth from which you were taken; because you are earth, and into earth you will depart. –

20 And Adam called the name of his woman Life, because she was the mother of all the living.

21 And the Lord God made tunics of skin for Adam and his woman and clothed them. –

22 And God said: Behold, Adam has become as one of us, to know good and evil, and now, lest he stretch out his hand and take from the tree of life and eat and live forever.

23 And the Lord God sent him out from the paradise of delight to work the earth from which he was taken.

24 And he cast Adam out and settled him opposite the paradise of delight, and appointed the cherubim and the flaming sword that turns, to guard the way of the tree of life.

Chapter 4

1 Now Adam knew Eva his woman, and having conceived she bore Cain and said: I acquired a man through God.

2 And she added to bear his brother Abel. And Abel became a shepherd of sheep, but Cain was working the earth.

3 And it happened after days that Cain brought from the fruits of the earth a sacrifice to the Lord,

4 and Abel also brought from the firstborn of his sheep and from their fat portions. And God looked upon Abel and upon his gifts,

5 but to Cain and to his sacrifices he did not attend. And Cain was exceedingly grieved, and his face fell.

6 And the Lord God said to Cain: Why have you become deeply grieved, and why has your face fallen?

7 Is it not that, if you offer rightly but do not divide rightly, you sinned? Be still; his turning is toward you, and you shall rule over him.

8 And Cain said to Abel his brother: Let us go through into the plain. And it happened while they were in the plain that Cain rose against Abel his brother and killed him.

9 And God said to Cain: Where is Abel your brother? But he said: I do not know. Am I my brother’s guard?

10 And God said: What did you do? A voice of your brother’s blood cries to me from the earth.

11 And now, accursed are you from the earth, which opened wide her mouth to receive your brother’s blood from your hand;

12 because you work the earth, it will no longer continue to give its strength to you; groaning and trembling you will be upon the earth.

13 And Cain said to the Lord: My guilt is greater than that I be forgiven;

14 if you cast me out today from the face of the earth, and from your face I shall be hidden, then I will be groaning and trembling upon the earth, and it will be that everyone finding me will kill me.

15 And the Lord God said to him: Not so; everyone who kills Cain shall suffer seven avenging penalties. And the Lord God placed a sign for Cain so that no one finding him would kill him.

16 And Cain went out from the face of God and dwelt in the land of Naid opposite Edem.

17 And Cain knew his woman, and having conceived she bore Enoch; and he was building a city, and he named the city after the name of his son Enoch.

18 And to Enoch was born Gaidad, and Gaidad begot Maiel, and Maiel begot Mathousala, and Mathousala begot Lamech.

19 And Lamech took two women for himself; the name of the one was Ada, and the name of the second Sella.

20 And Ada bore Jobel; he was the father of those dwelling in tents, cattle breeders.

21 And the name of his brother was Joubal; he was the one who demonstrated psaltery and lyre.

22 And Sella also bore Thobel, and he was a hammering smith of bronze and iron; and the sister of Thobel was Noema.

23 And Lamech said to his women: Ada and Sella, hear my voice; women of Lamech, give ear to my words, because I killed a man for a wound to me and a young man for a bruise to me,

24 because vengeance has been exacted seven times from Cain, but seventy-seven times from Lamech.

25 And Adam knew Eva his woman, and having conceived she bore a son and named his name Seth, saying: For God raised up another seed for me in place of Abel, whom Cain killed.

26 And to Seth there came to be a son, and he named his name Enos; he hoped to call upon the name of the Lord God.

Chapter 5

1 This is the book of the genesis of men; on the day God made Adam, according to God’s image he made him;

2 male and female he made them, and he blessed them. And he named their name Adam on the day he made them.

3 And Adam lived two hundred thirty years and begot according to his form and according to his image, and named his name Seth.

4 And the days of Adam after his begetting Seth were seven hundred years, and he begot sons and daughters.

5 And all the days of Adam which he lived were nine hundred thirty years, and he died.

6 And Seth lived two hundred five years and begot Enos.

7 And Seth lived after his begetting Enos seven hundred seven years, and he begot sons and daughters.

8 And all the days of Seth were nine hundred twelve years, and he died.

9 And Enos lived one hundred ninety years and begot Cainan.

10 And Enos lived after his begetting Cainan seven hundred fifteen years, and he begot sons and daughters.

11 And all the days of Enos were nine hundred five years, and he died.

12 And Cainan lived one hundred seventy years and begot Maleleel.

13 And Cainan lived after his begetting Maleleel seven hundred forty years, and he begot sons and daughters.

14 And all the days of Cainan were nine hundred ten years, and he died.

15 And Maleleel lived one hundred sixty-five years and begot Jared.

16 And Maleleel lived after his begetting Jared seven hundred thirty years, and he begot sons and daughters.

17 And all the days of Maleleel were eight hundred ninety-five years, and he died.

18 And Jared lived one hundred sixty-two years and begot Enoch.

19 And Jared lived after his begetting Enoch eight hundred years, and he begot sons and daughters.

20 And all the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty-two years, and he died.

21 And Enoch lived one hundred sixty-five years and begot Mathousala.

22 And Enoch pleased God for two hundred years after his begetting Mathousala, and he begot sons and daughters.

23 And all the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty-five years.

24 And Enoch pleased God and was not found, because God transferred him.

25 And Mathousala lived one hundred sixty-seven years and begot Lamech.

26 And Mathousala lived after his begetting Lamech eight hundred two years, and he begot sons and daughters.

27 And all the days of Mathousala which he lived were nine hundred sixty-nine years, and he died.

28 And Lamech lived one hundred eighty-eight years and begot a son

29 and named his name Noah, saying: This one will give us rest from our works and from the sorrows of our hands and from the earth which the Lord God cursed.

30 And Lamech lived after his begetting Noah five hundred sixty-five years, and he begot sons and daughters.

31 And all the days of Lamech were seven hundred fifty-three years, and he died.

32 And Noah was five hundred years old, and Noah begot three sons: Sem, Cham, Japheth.

Chapter 6

1 And it happened when men began to become many upon the earth, and daughters were born to them.

2 And the sons of God, seeing the daughters of men, that they were beautiful, took women for themselves from all whom they chose.

3 And the Lord God said: My spirit shall certainly not remain in these men forever, because they are flesh; but their days will be one hundred twenty years.

4 Now the giants were upon the earth in those days and after that, whenever the sons of God would go in to the daughters of men and would beget for themselves; those were the giants of old, the renowned men.

5 And the Lord God, seeing that the evils of men had multiplied upon the earth, and that everyone carefully thinks in his heart upon evil things all the days,

6 then God considered that he had made man upon the earth, and he pondered.

7 And God said: I will wipe away man whom I made from the face of the earth, from man as far as cattle and from creeping creatures as far as the flying creatures of heaven, because I became angry that I made them.

8 But Noah found grace before the Lord God.

9 Now these are the generations of Noah. Noah was a just man, being perfect in his generation; Noah pleased God.

10 And Noah begot three sons: Sem, Cham, Japheth.

11 But the earth was corrupted before God, and the earth was filled with injustice.

12 And the Lord God saw the earth, and it was corrupted, because every flesh corrupted his way upon the earth.

13 And God said to Noah: The time of every man has come before me, because the earth was filled with injustice from them; and behold, I am destroying them and the earth.

14 Therefore make yourself an ark from squared timbers. You shall make the ark into nests and asphalt it inside and outside with asphalt.

15 And thus you shall make the ark: the length of the ark shall be three hundred cubits, and the width fifty cubits, and its height thirty cubits.

16 Gathering together, you shall make the ark, and you shall finish it to a cubit above. And you shall make the door of the ark from the sides; with lower, second, and third stories you shall make it.

17 But I, behold, am bringing the flood, water upon the earth, to destroy every flesh in which there is a spirit of life beneath heaven; and whatever is upon the earth will come to an end.

18 And I will establish my covenant with you; and you shall enter into the ark, you and your sons and your woman and the women of your sons with you.

19 And from all the cattle and from all the creeping creatures and from all the beasts and from every flesh, two by two from all you shall bring into the ark, so that you may nourish them with yourself; male and female they shall be.

20 From all the birds, the flying creatures according to kind, and from all the cattle according to kind, and from all the creeping creatures that creep upon the earth according to their kind, two by two from all will enter toward you to be nourished with you, male and female.

21 And you shall take for yourself from all the foods which you will eat and gather them to yourself, and it shall be for you and for them to eat.

22 And Noah did all things, as many as the Lord God commanded him; thus he did.

Chapter 7

1 And the Lord God said to Noah: Enter, you and all your house, into the ark, because I saw you as just before me in this generation.

2 And from the clean cattle bring in toward you seven by seven, male and female, but from the cattle that are not clean two by two, male and female,

3 and from the clean flying creatures of heaven seven by seven, male and female, and from the flying creatures that are not clean two by two, male and female, to sustain seed upon all the earth.

4 For yet seven days, and I am bringing rain upon the earth for forty days and forty nights, and I will wipe away every thing that has arisen which I made from the face of the earth.

5 And Noah did all things, as many as the Lord God commanded him.

6 Now Noah was six hundred years old, and the flood of water came to be upon the earth.

7 And Noah and his sons and his woman and the women of his sons with him entered into the ark because of the water of the flood.

8 And from the flying creatures and from the clean cattle and from the cattle that were not clean and from all the creeping creatures upon the earth,

9 two by two they entered toward Noah into the ark, male and female, just as God commanded him.

10 And it happened after the seven days that the water of the flood came to be upon the earth.

11 In the six hundredth year in the life of Noah, in the second month, on the twenty-seventh of the month, on that day all the springs of the abyss burst, and the floodgates of heaven were opened,

12 and the rain came upon the earth for forty days and forty nights.

13 On that day Noah, Sem, Cham, Japheth, the sons of Noah, and Noah’s woman and the three women of his sons with him entered into the ark.

14 And all the beasts according to kind and all the cattle according to kind and every creeping creature moving upon the earth according to kind and every flying creature according to kind

15 entered toward Noah into the ark, two by two from every flesh in which there is a spirit of life.

16 And those entering, male and female from every flesh, entered, just as God commanded Noah. And the Lord God closed the ark from outside him.

17 And the flood came to be for forty days and forty nights upon the earth, and the water multiplied and lifted the ark, and it was raised from the earth.

18 And the water prevailed and multiplied exceedingly upon the earth, and the ark was borne above the water.

19 And the water prevailed exceedingly, exceedingly upon the earth and covered all the high mountains which were beneath heaven.

20 The water was raised fifteen cubits above and covered all the high mountains.

21 And every flesh moving upon the earth died—of the flying creatures and the cattle and the beasts—and every creeping creature moving upon the earth, and every man.

22 And all things that have breath of life, and everyone who was upon dry land, died.

23 And he wiped away every standing thing which was upon the face of all the earth, from man as far as cattle and creeping creatures and the flying creatures of heaven, and they were wiped away from the earth. And Noah alone was left, and those with him in the ark.

24 And the water was raised upon the earth for one hundred fifty days.

Chapter 8

1 And God remembered Noah and all the beasts and all the cattle and all the flying creatures and all the creeping creatures, as many as were with him in the ark; and God brought a wind upon the earth, and the water subsided,

2 and the springs of the abyss and the floodgates of heaven were covered, and the rain from heaven was held back.

3 And the water was receding as it went from the earth; the water receded and diminished after one hundred fifty days.

4 And the ark settled in the seventh month, on the twenty-seventh of the month, upon the mountains of Ararat.

5 And the water, as it went, diminished until the tenth month; but in the eleventh month, on the first of the month, the heads of the mountains were seen. –

6 And it happened after forty days that Noah opened the window of the ark which he made,

7 and sent out the raven to see whether the water had abated; and having gone out, it did not return until the water dried from the earth.

8 And he sent out the dove after it to see whether the water had abated from the face of the earth;

9 and the dove, not finding a resting place for its feet, returned to him into the ark, because water was over every face of all the earth; and stretching out his hand, he took it and brought it in to himself into the ark.

10 And having waited yet another seven days, he again sent the dove out from the ark.

11 And the dove returned to him toward evening and had an olive leaf, a twig, in its mouth, and Noah knew that the water had abated from the earth.

12 And having waited yet another seven days, he again sent the dove out, and it did not continue to return to him any more. –

13 And it happened in the six hundred first year in the life of Noah, in the first month, on the first of the month, that the water disappeared from the earth; and Noah uncovered the roof of the ark which he made and saw that the water had disappeared from the face of the earth.

14 And in the second month, on the twenty-seventh of the month, the earth was dried.

15 And the Lord God said to Noah, saying:

16 Come out from the ark, you and your woman and your sons and the women of your sons with you,

17 and bring out with yourself all the beasts, as many as are with you, and every flesh from flying creatures as far as cattle, and every creeping creature moving upon the earth; and increase and multiply upon the earth.

18 And Noah and his woman and his sons and the women of his sons with him came out,

19 and all the beasts and all the cattle and every flying creature and every creeping creature moving upon the earth according to their kind came out from the ark.

20 And Noah built an altar to God and took from all the clean cattle and from all the clean flying creatures and offered whole burnt offerings upon the altar.

21 And the Lord God smelled a scent of fragrance, and the Lord God, having considered, said: I will no longer continue to curse the earth because of the works of men, because the mind of man is carefully set upon evil things from youth; therefore I will no longer continue to strike every living flesh as I did.

22 All the days of the earth, seedtime and harvest, cold and heat, summer and spring, day and night, shall not cease.

Chapter 9

1 And God blessed Noah and his sons and said to them: Increase and multiply and fill the earth and rule over it.

2 And your terror and fear will be upon all the beasts of the earth and upon all the birds of heaven and upon all the things moving upon the earth and upon all the fish of the sea; I have given them under your hands.

3 And every creeping thing that is living shall be food for you; as the green plants, I have given you all things.

4 Only, flesh with blood of life you shall not eat.

5 For indeed your blood, that of your souls, I will require; from the hand of every beast I will require it, and from the hand of a man, a brother, I will require the soul of man.

6 The one pouring out a man’s blood shall be poured out in exchange for his blood, because in God’s image I made man.

7 But you, increase and multiply and fill the earth and multiply upon it.

8 And God said to Noah and to his sons with him, saying:

9 I, behold, raise up my covenant with you and with your seed after you,

10 and with every living soul with you, from birds and from cattle and all the beasts of the earth, as many as are with you, from all those who came out from the ark.

11 And I will establish my covenant with you, and every flesh will no longer die from the water of the flood, and there will no longer be a flood of water to destroy all the earth. –

12 And the Lord God said to Noah: This is the sign of the covenant which I give between me and you and between every living soul which is with you, into eternal generations.

13 I place my bow in the cloud, and it shall be a sign of a covenant between me and the earth.

14 And it shall be, when I gather clouds over the earth, that my bow will be seen in the cloud,

15 and I will remember my covenant which is between me and you and between every living soul in every flesh, and the water will no longer become a flood so as to wipe away every flesh.

16 And my bow will be in the cloud, and I will see it so as to remember an eternal covenant between me and between every living soul in every flesh which is upon the earth.

17 And God said to Noah: This is the sign of the covenant which I set between me and between every flesh which is upon the earth.

18 Now the sons of Noah who came out from the ark were Sem, Cham, Japheth; Cham was the father of Chanaan.

19 These three are the sons of Noah; from these they were scattered over all the earth.

20 And Noah began to be a man cultivating the earth, and he planted a vineyard.

21 And he drank from the wine and became drunk and was stripped naked in his house.

22 And Cham, the father of Chanaan, saw the nakedness of his father and, having gone out, announced it to his two brothers outside.

23 And Sem and Japheth, having taken the garment, placed it upon their two backs and went backward-facing and covered the nakedness of their father; and their faces were backward-facing, and they did not see the nakedness of their father.

24 And Noah sobered up from the wine and knew what his younger son had done to him,

25 and he said: Accursed is Chanaan; a servant, a household slave, he shall be to his brothers.

26 And he said: Blessed be the Lord, the God of Sem, and Chanaan shall be his servant.

27 May God broaden for Japheth, and let him dwell in the houses of Sem, and let Chanaan become their servant.

28 And Noah lived after the flood three hundred fifty years.

29 And all the days of Noah were nine hundred fifty years, and he died.

Chapter 10

1 Now these are the generations of the sons of Noah—Sem, Cham, Japheth—and sons were born to them after the flood.

2 The sons of Japheth: Gamer and Magog and Madai and Jovan and Elisa and Thobel and Mosoch and Thiras.

3 And the sons of Gamer: Aschanaz and Riphath and Thorgama.

4 And the sons of Jovan: Elisa and Tharsis, Kitians, Rhodians.

5 From these the islands of the nations were separated in their land, each according to language, in their tribes and in their nations.

6 And the sons of Cham: Chous and Mesraim, Phoud and Chanaan.

7 And the sons of Chous: Saba and Evila and Sabatha and Regma and Sabacatha. And the sons of Regma: Saba and Dadan.

8 And Chous begot Nebrod. He began to be a giant upon the earth.

9 He was a giant hunter before the Lord God; therefore they will say: Like Nebrod, a giant hunter before the Lord.

10 And the beginning of his kingdom was Babylon and Orech and Archad and Chalanne in the land of Sennaar.

11 From that land Assour went out and built Nineve and the city Rooboth and Chalach,

12 and Dasem between Nineve and Chalach; this is the great city. –

13 And Mesraim begot the Loudeim and the Enemetiim and the Labiim and the Nephthaliim,

14 and the Patrosoniim and the Chasloniim, from where the Phylistiim went out from there, and the Caphthoriim. –

15 And Chanaan begot Sidon the firstborn and the Chettite,

16 and the Jebousite and the Amorrite and the Gergesite,

17 and the Evite and the Aroukite and the Asennite,

18 and the Aradian and the Samarite and Amathi. And after this the tribes of the Chananeans were scattered,

19 and the boundaries of the Chananeans came to be from Sidon until coming to Gerara and Gaza, until coming to Sodoma and Gomorra, Adama and Seboim, as far as Lasa. –

20 These are the sons of Cham in their tribes, according to their languages, in their countries and in their nations.

21 And to Sem also, the father of all the sons of Eber and brother of Japheth the elder, sons were born.

22 The sons of Sem: Ailam and Assour and Arphaxad and Loud and Aram and Cainan.

23 And the sons of Aram: Os and Oul and Gather and Mosoch.

24 And Arphaxad begot Cainan, and Cainan begot Sala, and Sala begot Eber.

25 And to Eber came to be two sons; the name of the one was Phalek, because in his days the earth was divided, and the name of his brother was Jektan.

26 And Jektan begot Elmodad and Saleph and Asarmoth and Jarach,

27 and Odorra and Aizel and Dekla,

28 and Abimeel and Sabeu,

29 and Ouphir and Evila and Jobab. All these were sons of Jektan.

30 And their dwelling was from Masse until coming to Sophira, a mountain of the east.

31 These are the sons of Sem in their tribes, according to their languages, in their countries and in their nations.

32 These are the tribes of the sons of Noah according to their generations, according to their nations; from these the islands of the nations were scattered upon the earth after the flood.

Chapter 11

1 And the whole earth was one lip, and one voice for all.

2 And it happened, when they moved from the east, that they found a plain in the land of Sennaar and dwelt there.

3 And a man said to his neighbor: Come, let us make bricks and bake them with fire. And the brick became stone for them, and asphalt was their clay.

4 And they said: Come, let us build for ourselves a city and a tower whose head will be as far as heaven, and let us make a name for ourselves before being scattered over the face of all the earth.

5 And the Lord descended to see the city and the tower which the sons of men built.

6 And the Lord said: Behold, one race and one lip belong to all, and this they began to do; and now nothing of all that they may set themselves to do will fail them.

7 Come, and having descended, let us confuse their tongue there, so that each may not hear the voice of his neighbor.

8 And the Lord scattered them from there over the face of all the earth, and they ceased building the city and the tower.

9 Because of this its name was called Confusion, because there the Lord confused the lips of all the earth, and from there the Lord God scattered them over the face of all the earth.

10 And these are the generations of Sem. Sem was one hundred years old when he begot Arphaxad, in the second year after the flood.

11 And Sem lived five hundred years after his begetting Arphaxad, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

12 And Arphaxad lived one hundred thirty-five years and begot Cainan.

13 And Arphaxad lived four hundred thirty years after his begetting Cainan, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died. And Cainan lived one hundred thirty years and begot Sala. And Cainan lived three hundred thirty years after his begetting Sala, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

14 And Sala lived one hundred thirty years and begot Eber.

15 And Sala lived three hundred thirty years after his begetting Eber, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

16 And Eber lived one hundred thirty-four years and begot Phalek.

17 And Eber lived three hundred seventy years after his begetting Phalek, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

18 And Phalek lived one hundred thirty years and begot Ragau.

19 And Phalek lived two hundred nine years after his begetting Ragau, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

20 And Ragau lived one hundred thirty-two years and begot Serouch.

21 And Ragau lived two hundred seven years after his begetting Serouch, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

22 And Serouch lived one hundred thirty years and begot Nachor.

23 And Serouch lived two hundred years after his begetting Nachor, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

24 And Nachor lived seventy-nine years and begot Thara.

25 And Nachor lived one hundred twenty-nine years after his begetting Thara, and he begot sons and daughters, and he died.

26 And Thara lived seventy years and begot Abram and Nachor and Arran.

27 Now these are the generations of Thara. Thara begot Abram and Nachor and Arran, and Arran begot Lot.

28 And Arran died before Thara his father in the land in which he was born, in the country of the Chaldeans.

29 And Abram and Nachor took women for themselves; the name of Abram’s woman was Sara, and the name of Nachor’s woman was Melcha, daughter of Arran, father of Melcha and father of Jescha.

30 And Sara was barren and did not bear children.

31 And Thara took Abram his son and Lot, son of Arran, son of his son, and Sara his daughter-in-law, woman of Abram his son, and brought them out from the country of the Chaldeans to go into the land of Chanaan; and he came as far as Charran and dwelt there.

32 And the days of Thara in Charran were two hundred five years, and Thara died in Charran.

Chapter 12

1 And the Lord said to Abram: Go out from your land and from your kin and from the house of your father into the land which I may show you;

2 and I will make you into a great nation and bless you and magnify your name, and you shall be blessed;

3 and I will bless those blessing you, and those cursing you I will curse; and in you all the tribes of the earth will be blessed.

4 And Abram went just as the Lord spoke to him, and Lot went with him. And Abram was seventy-five years old when he went out from Charran.

5 And Abram took Sara his woman and Lot the son of his brother and all their possessions, as many as they acquired, and every soul which they acquired in Charran, and they went out to go into the land of Chanaan, and they came into the land of Chanaan. –

6 And Abram traveled through the land along its length as far as the place Sychem, at the high oak; and the Chananeans then dwelt in the land.

7 And the Lord appeared to Abram and said to him: To your seed I will give this land. And there Abram built an altar to the Lord who appeared to him.

8 And he departed from there to the mountain east of Baethel and set up his tent there, Baethel toward the sea and Angai toward the east; and there he built an altar to the Lord and called upon the name of the Lord.

9 And Abram struck camp and, having gone, encamped in the wilderness.

10 And a famine came upon the land, and Abram went down into Egypt to sojourn there, because the famine grew strong upon the land.

11 And it happened when Abram drew near to enter into Egypt that Abram said to Sara his woman: I know that you are a woman beautiful in face;

12 therefore it will be, whenever the Egyptians see you, that they will say: This is his woman, and they will kill me, but they will preserve you.

13 Therefore say: I am his sister, so that it may be well for me because of you, and my soul will live on account of you.

14 And it happened when Abram entered into Egypt that the Egyptians, seeing the woman, that she was exceedingly beautiful,

15 and the rulers of Pharao saw her and praised her to Pharao and brought her into the house of Pharao.

16 And they treated Abram well because of her, and he came to have sheep and calves and donkeys, male servants and female servants, mules and camels.

17 And God tested Pharao and his house with great and evil tests concerning Sara, the woman of Abram.

18 And Pharao called Abram and said: What is this you did to me, that you did not announce to me that she is your woman?

19 Why did you say: She is my sister? And I took her for myself as a woman. And now, behold, your woman is before you; take her and run away.

20 And Pharao commanded men concerning Abram, to escort him and his woman and all that he had, and Lot with him.

Chapter 13

1 And Abram went up from Egypt, he and his woman and all that was his and Lot with him, into the wilderness.

2 And Abram was exceedingly rich in cattle and silver and gold.

3 And he went from where he came, into the wilderness as far as Baethel, as far as the place where his tent formerly was, between Baethel and Angai,

4 to the place of the altar which he made there at first; and there Abram called upon the name of the Lord.

5 And Lot, who was journeying with Abram, had sheep and cattle and tents.

6 And the land did not have room for them to dwell together, because their possessions were many, and they could not dwell together.

7 And there was a conflict between the shepherds of Abram’s cattle and the shepherds of Lot’s cattle; and the Chananeans and the Pherezites then dwelt in the land.

8 And Abram said to Lot: Let there be no conflict between me and you and between my shepherds and your shepherds, because we are men, brothers.

9 Is not, behold, all the land before you? Separate from me; if you go to the left, I will go to the right, but if you go to the right, I will go to the left.

10 And Lot, lifting his eyes, saw all the region of the Jordan, that all of it was irrigated—before God destroyed Sodoma and Gomorra—like the paradise of God and like the land of Egypt until coming to Zogora.

11 And Lot chose for himself all the region of the Jordan, and Lot departed from the east, and they separated, each from his brother.

12 And Abram dwelt in the land of Chanaan, but Lot dwelt in a city of the region and tented in Sodoma.

13 But the men in Sodoma were evil and exceedingly sinful before God.

14 And God said to Abram after Lot separated from him: Looking up with your eyes, see from the place where you now are toward north and southwest and east and sea;

15 because all the land which you see, I will give it to you and to your seed forever.

16 And I will make your seed like the sand of the earth; if anyone is able to count the sand of the earth, then your seed will be counted.

17 Rise and travel through the land, both its length and its width, because I will give it to you.

18 And Abram, having moved his tent, came and dwelt beside the oak Mamre, which was in Chebron, and there he built an altar to the Lord.

Chapter 14

1 And it happened in the reign of Amarfal king of Sennaar, Arioch king of Ellasar and Chodollogomor king of Ailam and Thargal king of nations

2 made war with Balla king of Sodoma and with Barsa king of Gomorra and Sennaar king of Adama and Symobor king of Seboim and the king of Balak [this is Segor].

3 All these agreed together at the salt ravine [this is the sea of salts].

4 For twelve years they served Chodollogomor, but in the thirteenth year they revolted.

5 And in the fourteenth year Chodollogomor and the kings with him came and cut down the giants in Astaroth Karnain and strong nations together with them and the Ommaeans in the city Saue,

6 and the Chorraeans in the mountains of Seir as far as the terebinth of Pharan, which is in the wilderness.

7 And having returned, they came to the spring of Judgment [this is Kades] and cut down all the rulers of Amalek and the Amorrites dwelling in Asasanthamar.

8 And the king of Sodoma and the king of Gomorra and the king of Adama and the king of Seboim and the king of Balak [this is Segor] went out and drew themselves up against them for war in the salt valley,

9 against Chodollogomor king of Ailam and Thargal king of nations and Amarfal king of Sennaar and Arioch king of Ellasar, the four kings against the five.

10 And the salt valley was wells, wells of asphalt; and the king of Sodoma and the king of Gomorra fled and fell there, but those remaining fled into the hill country.

11 And they took all the horse of Sodoma and Gomorra and all their foods and departed.

12 And they also took Lot, the son of Abram’s brother, and his baggage and went away, for he was dwelling in Sodoma.

13 And one of those who were saved arrived and announced it to Abram the passer. Now he dwelt by the oak of Mamre the Amorite, brother of Eschol and brother of Aunan, who were sworn allies of Abram.

14 And Abram, hearing that Lot his brother had been taken captive, counted his own homeborn men, three hundred eighteen, and pursued after them as far as Dan.

15 And he fell upon them at night, he and his servants, and struck them and pursued them as far as Choba, which is to the left of Damascus.

16 And he returned all the horse of Sodoma, and returned Lot his brother and his possessions and the women and the people.

17 And the king of Sodoma went out to meet him—after his returning from the cutting down of Chodollogomor and the kings with him—to the valley Saue [this was the plain of the king].

18 And Melchisedek king of Salem brought out breads and wine; and he was priest of God Most High.

19 And he blessed Abram and said: Blessed is Abram by God Most High, who created heaven and earth,

20 and blessed is God Most High, who delivered your enemies under your hand. And he gave him a tenth from all.

21 And the king of Sodoma said to Abram: Give me the men, but take the horse for yourself.

22 And Abram said to the king of Sodoma: I will stretch out my hand toward God Most High, who created heaven and earth,

23 if I take from a cord as far as a shoe-fastener from all that is yours, so that you may not say: I made Abram rich;

24 except what the young men ate and the share of the men who journeyed with me—Eschol, Aunan, Mamre—these shall take a share.

Chapter 15

1 And after these words a word of the Lord came to Abram in a vision, saying: Do not be afraid, Abram; I defend you. Your reward will be exceedingly great.

2 And Abram says: Master, what will you give me? But I am being released childless, and the son of Masek, my homeborn woman, is this Damascus Eliezer.

3 And Abram said: Since you did not give me seed, my homeborn servant will inherit me.

4 And immediately a voice of the Lord came to him, saying: This one will not inherit you, but one who will come out from you, he will inherit you.

5 And he brought him outside and said to him: Look up now into heaven and count the stars, if you are able to count them. And he said: Thus shall your seed be.

6 And Abram believed God, and it was reckoned to him for righteousness.

7 And he said to him: I am God who brought you out from the country of the Chaldeans so as to give you this land to inherit.

8 And he said: Master, Lord, according to what shall I know that I will inherit it?

9 And he said to him: Take for me a three-year-old heifer and a three-year-old goat and a three-year-old ram and a turtledove and a dove.

10 And he took all these for him and divided them in the middle and placed them facing one another, but he did not divide the birds.

11 And birds came down upon the bodies, their divided pieces, and Abram sat together with them.

12 And near sunset a trance fell upon Abram, and behold, a great dark fear was falling upon him.

13 And it was said to Abram: Knowing, you shall know that your seed will be a sojourner in a land not its own, and they will enslave them and harm them and humble them for four hundred years.

14 But the nation which they may serve, I will judge; and after these things they will come out here with much baggage.

15 But you will depart to your fathers with peace, buried in a good old age.

16 And in the fourth generation they will return here, for the sins of the Amorrites have not yet been filled up until now.

17 And when the sun was becoming toward setting, a flame came to be, and behold, a smoking oven and torches of fire which passed between these divided pieces.

18 On that day the Lord made a covenant with Abram, saying: To your seed I will give this land, from the river of Egypt as far as the great river, the river Euphrates,

19 the Kainites and the Kenezites and the Kedmoneans,

20 and the Chettites and the Pherezites and the Raphain,

21 and the Amorrites and the Chananeans and the Evites and the Gergesites and the Jebousites.

Chapter 16

1 Now Sara, the woman of Abram, did not bear for him. And she had an Egyptian female servant whose name was Agar.

2 And Sara said to Abram: Behold, the Lord has shut me up from bearing; therefore go in to my female servant, so that you may father children from her. And Abram listened to the voice of Sara.

3 And Sara, the woman of Abram, took Agar the Egyptian, her own female servant—after Abram had dwelt ten years in the land of Chanaan—and gave her to Abram her man, to him as a woman.

4 And he went in to Agar, and she conceived and saw that she had in the womb, and her mistress was dishonored before her.

5 And Sara said to Abram: I am wronged from you. I gave my female servant into your bosom, but seeing that she had in the womb, I was dishonored before her. May God judge between me and you.

6 And Abram said to Sara: Behold, your female servant is in your hands; deal with her as may be pleasing to you. And Sara harmed her, and she fled from her face.

7 And an angel of the Lord found her at the spring of water in the wilderness, at the spring on the way to Sour.

8 And the angel of the Lord said to her: Agar, female servant of Sara, from where are you coming, and where are you going? And she said: I am fleeing away from the face of Sara my mistress.

9 And the angel of the Lord said to her: Return to your mistress and be humbled under her hands.

10 And the angel of the Lord said to her: Multiplying, I will multiply your seed, and it will not be numbered because of the multitude.

11 And the angel of the Lord said to her: Behold, you have in the womb and will bear a son, and you shall call his name Ismael, because the Lord listened to your humiliation.

12 He will be a rustic man; his hands will be against all, and the hands of all against him, and he will dwell before the face of all his brothers.

13 And Agar called the name of the Lord who was speaking to her: You are God who looked upon me; because she said: For even face-to-face I saw him who appeared to me.

14 Because of this she called the well Well Where I Saw Face-to-face; behold, it is between Kades and Barad.

15 And Agar bore a son for Abram, and Abram called the name of his son, whom Agar bore for him, Ismael.

16 And Abram was eighty-six years old when Agar bore Ismael for Abram.

Chapter 17

1 And Abram came to be ninety-nine years old, and the Lord appeared to Abram and said to him: I am your God; be well pleasing before me and become blameless,

2 and I will set my covenant between me and between you and multiply you exceedingly.

3 And Abram fell upon his face, and God spoke to him, saying:

4 And I, behold, my covenant is with you, and you shall be father of a multitude of nations.

5 And your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name shall be Abraham, because I have made you father of many nations.

6 And I will increase you exceedingly, exceedingly, and make you into nations, and kings will come out from you.

7 And I will establish my covenant between me and between you and between your seed after you throughout their generations, as an eternal covenant, to be God of you and of your seed after you.

8 And I will give to you and to your seed after you the land in which you sojourn, all the land of Chanaan, as an eternal possession, and I will be God to them. –

9 And God said to Abraham: But you shall preserve my covenant, you and your seed after you throughout their generations.

10 And this is the covenant which you shall preserve between me and you and between your seed after you throughout their generations: every male of yours shall be circumcised,

11 and you shall circumcise the flesh of your foreskin, and it shall be as a sign of a covenant between me and you.

12 And every male child of yours eight days old shall be circumcised throughout your generations, the homeborn of your house and the one bought with silver from any foreigner’s son who is not from your seed.

13 With circumcision shall the homeborn of your house and the one bought with silver be circumcised, and my covenant shall be upon your flesh as an eternal covenant.

14 And an uncircumcised male who will not be circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin on the eighth day—that soul will be utterly destroyed from its race, because he scattered my covenant.

15 And God said to Abraham: Sara your woman—her name shall not be called Sara, but Sarra shall be her name.

16 And I will bless her and give you a child from her; and I will bless him, and he will become nations, and kings of nations will be from him.

17 And Abraham fell upon his face and laughed and said in his mind, saying: Will one be born to a hundred-year-old, and will Sarra, being ninety years old, give birth?

18 And Abraham said to God: Let this Ismael live before you.

19 And God said to Abraham: Yes; behold, Sarra your woman will bear you a son, and you shall call his name Isaac, and I will establish my covenant with him as an eternal covenant and with his seed after him.

20 And concerning Ismael, behold, I listened to you. Behold, I have blessed him, and I will increase him and multiply him exceedingly. He will beget twelve nations, and I will make him into a great nation.

21 But my covenant I will establish with Isaac, whom Sarra will bear for you at this time in the other year.

22 And he finished speaking to him, and God ascended from Abraham.

23 And Abraham took Ismael his son and all his homeborn men and all those bought with silver and every male of the men in Abraham’s house and circumcised their foreskins at the time of that day, just as God spoke to him.

24 And Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he circumcised the flesh of his foreskin.

25 And Ismael his son was thirteen years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.

26 At the time of that day Abraham and Ismael his son were circumcised;

27 and all the men of his house and the homeborn and those bought with silver from foreign nations, he circumcised them.

Chapter 18

1 And God appeared to him by the oak Mamre while he was sitting at the door of his tent at midday.

2 And looking up with his eyes, he saw, and behold, three men stood above him; and seeing them, he ran from the door of his tent to meet them and bowed to the earth

3 and said: Lord, if indeed I found grace before you, do not pass by your servant.

4 Let water now be taken, and let them wash your feet, and cool yourselves under the tree;

5 and I will take bread, and you will eat, and after this you will pass on into your way, for this reason you turned aside toward your servant. And they said: Do thus, just as you have said.

6 And Abraham hurried to the tent to Sarra and said to her: Hurry and mix three measures of fine flour and make ash-cakes.

7 And Abraham ran to the cattle and took a tender and good calf and gave it to the servant, and he hurried to prepare it.

8 And he took butter and milk and the calf which he prepared and set them before them, and they ate; and he stood beside them under the tree.

9 And he said to him: Where is Sarra your woman? And answering, he said: Behold, in the tent.

10 And he said: Returning, I will come to you at this time, at the appointed hour, and Sarra your woman will have a son. And Sarra heard at the door of the tent, being behind him.

11 And Abraham and Sarra were old, advanced in days, and it had ceased for Sarra to have the things of women.

12 And Sarra laughed within herself, saying: It has not yet happened to me until now, and my lord is old.

13 And the Lord said to Abraham: Why is it that Sarra laughed within herself, saying: Will I then truly give birth? But I have grown old.

14 Is a word powerless with God? At this time, at the appointed hour, I will return to you, and Sarra will have a son.

15 But Sarra denied it, saying: I did not laugh, for she was afraid. And he said: No, but you laughed.

16 And the men, rising up from there, looked down upon the face of Sodoma and Gomorra, and Abraham journeyed with them, escorting them.

17 And the Lord said: Shall I hide from Abraham my servant the things which I am doing?

18 And Abraham, coming to be, will be a great and numerous nation, and in him all the nations of the earth will be blessed.

19 For I knew that he will command his sons and his house after him, and they will guard the ways of the Lord, to do righteousness and judgment, so that the Lord may bring upon Abraham all the things which he spoke to him.

20 And the Lord said: The cry of Sodoma and Gomorra has multiplied, and their sins are exceedingly great;

21 therefore, having gone down, I will see whether they are being completed according to their cry which is coming to me, but if not, so that I may know.

22 And the men, turning away from there, came into Sodoma, but Abraham was standing before the Lord.

23 And Abraham drew near and said: Surely you will not destroy a righteous one together with an impious one, and the righteous one will be as the impious one?

24 If there are fifty righteous ones in the city, will you destroy them? Will you not spare the whole place on account of the fifty righteous ones, if they are in it?

25 In no way will you act according to this word, to kill a righteous one together with an impious one, and the righteous one will be as the impious one. In no way; will you, the one judging all the earth, not do judgment?

26 And the Lord said: If I find in Sodoma fifty righteous ones in the city, I will spare the whole place because of them.

27 And Abraham answered and said: Now I began to speak to the Lord, but I am earth and ashes.

28 But if the fifty righteous ones are diminished by five, will you destroy all the city because of the five? And he said: I will certainly not destroy it if I find forty-five there.

29 And he continued still to speak to him and said: But if forty are found there? And he said: I will certainly not destroy it on account of the forty.

30 And he said: Let it not be, Lord, if I speak: But if thirty are found there? And he said: I will certainly not destroy it if I find thirty there.

31 And he said: Since I have to speak to the Lord: But if twenty are found there? And he said: I will certainly not destroy it on account of the twenty.

32 And he said: Let it not be, Lord, if I speak yet once: But if ten are found there? And he said: I will certainly not destroy it on account of the ten.

33 And the Lord departed when he ceased speaking to Abraham, and Abraham returned to his place.

Chapter 19

1 And the two angels came into Sodoma at evening; and Lot was sitting by the gate of Sodoma. And Lot, seeing them, rose up to meet them and bowed with his face to the earth

2 and said: Behold, lords, turn aside into the house of your servant and lodge and wash your feet, and having risen early, you will depart into your way. But they said: No, but we will lodge in the square.

3 And he pressed them strongly, and they turned aside toward him and entered into his house. And he made a drinking feast for them and baked unleavened loaves for them, and they ate.

4 Before they lay down, the men of the city, the Sodomites, surrounded the house, from young man as far as elder, all the people together,

5 and they called Lot out and said to him: Where are the men who entered toward you at night? Bring them out toward us, so that we may have intercourse with them.

6 And Lot went out toward them to the forecourt, and he shut the door behind him.

7 And he said to them: By no means, brothers; do not act wickedly.

8 And I have two daughters who have not known a man; I will bring them out toward you, and use them just as may please you. Only do nothing unjust to these men, for this reason they came under the shelter of my beams.

9 But they said: Stand away there. You alone came to sojourn; surely also to judge judgment? Therefore now we will harm you more than them. And they pressed the man Lot exceedingly and drew near to crush the door.

10 But the men, stretching out their hands, drew Lot inward toward themselves into the house and shut the door of the house.

11 And they struck the men who were at the door of the house with blindness, from small as far as great, and they were exhausted seeking the door.

12 And the men said to Lot: Is there anyone of yours here—sons-in-law or sons or daughters? Or if anyone else of yours is in the city, bring them out from this place,

13 because we are destroying this place, because their cry was raised before the Lord, and the Lord sent us to wipe it out.

14 And Lot went out and spoke to his sons-in-law who had taken his daughters and said: Rise and go out from this place, because the Lord is wiping out the city. But he seemed to be joking before his sons-in-law.

15 And when dawn was coming, the angels hurried Lot, saying: Arise, take your woman and your two daughters whom you have, and go out, lest you perish together with the lawless deeds of the city.

16 And they were troubled; and the angels seized his hand and the hand of his woman and the hands of his two daughters, when the Lord spared him.

17 And it happened when they brought them outside that they said: Saving, save your own soul. Do not look around to the things behind, nor stand in all the region; save yourself to the mountain, lest you be taken along with them.

18 And Lot said to them: I beg, Lord;

19 since your servant found mercy before you and you magnified your righteousness which you do upon me, for my soul to live, but I will not be able to be brought safely to the mountain, lest the evil things overtake me and I die,

20 behold, this city is near for me to take refuge there, and it is small; there I will be saved. Is it not small? And my soul will live.

21 And he said to him: Behold, I have marveled at your face also in this matter, so as not to overthrow the city concerning which you spoke.

22 Therefore hurry to be saved there, for I will not be able to do a thing until you enter there. Because of this he called the name of that city Segor.

23 The sun came out upon the earth, and Lot entered into Segor,

24 and the Lord rained sulfur and fire upon Sodoma and Gomorra from the Lord out of heaven,

25 and overthrew these cities and all the surrounding region and all those dwelling in the cities and all the things springing up from the earth.

26 And his woman looked to the things behind and became a pillar of salt.

27 And Abraham rose early in the morning to the place where he had stood before the Lord,

28 and he looked upon the face of Sodoma and Gomorra and upon the face of the land of the region and saw, and behold, a flame of the earth was ascending like steam of a furnace.

29 And it happened, when the Lord wiped out all the cities of the surrounding region, that God remembered Abraham and sent Lot out from the midst of the overthrow when the Lord overthrew the cities in which Lot dwelt.

30 And Lot went up from Segor and sat in the mountain, and his two daughters with him, for he was afraid to dwell in Segor. And he dwelt in the cave, he and his two daughters with him.

31 And the elder said to the younger: Our father is older, and there is no one upon the earth who will go in toward us, as is fitting to all the earth.

32 Come, and let us give our father wine to drink and lie with him, and let us raise up seed from our father.

33 And they gave their father wine to drink on this night, and the elder went in and lay with her father that night, and he did not know when she lay down and rose.

34 And it happened on the next day that the elder said to the younger: Behold, I lay yesterday with our father. Let us give him wine to drink this night also, and go in and lie with him, and let us raise up seed from our father.

35 And on that night also they gave their father wine to drink, and the younger went in and lay with her father, and he did not know when she lay down and rose.

36 And the two daughters of Lot conceived from their father.

37 And the elder bore a son and called his name Moab, saying: From my father. He is the father of the Moabites until today.

38 And the younger also bore a son and called his name Amman, Son of My Race. He is the father of the Ammanites until today.

Chapter 20

1 And Abraham moved from there into the land toward the southwest and dwelt between Kades and Sour and sojourned in Gerara.

2 And Abraham said concerning Sarra his woman: She is my sister, for he was afraid to say: She is my woman, lest the men of the city kill him because of her. And Abimelech king of Gerara sent and took Sarra.

3 And God entered toward Abimelech in sleep at night and said: Behold, you are dying concerning the woman whom you took, but she is one who lives with a man.

4 But Abimelech had not touched her, and he said: Lord, will you destroy an ignorant and righteous nation?

5 Did he not say to me: She is my sister? And she said to me: He is my brother. In a clean heart and in righteousness of hands I did this.

6 And God said to him in sleep: I also knew that you did this in a clean heart, and I spared you so that you would not sin against me; because of this I did not permit you to touch her.

7 But now give the woman back to the man, because he is a prophet, and he will pray for you and you will live; but if you do not give her back, know that you will die, you and all that is yours.

8 And Abimelech rose early in the morning and called all his servants and spoke all these words into their ears, and all the men were exceedingly afraid.

9 And Abimelech called Abraham and said to him: What is this you did to us? Did we perhaps sin against you, that you brought upon me and upon my kingdom a great sin? A deed which no one will do, you have done to me.

10 And Abimelech said to Abraham: What did you see that you did this?

11 And Abraham said: For I said: Perhaps there is no reverence for God in this place, and they will kill me on account of my woman.

12 For indeed she truly is my sister from my father, but not from my mother; and she became my woman.

13 And it happened when God brought me out from my father’s house that I said to her: This righteousness you shall do upon me: in every place into which we may enter there, say of me: He is my brother.

14 And Abimelech took one thousand didrachmas, sheep and calves and male servants and female servants, and gave them to Abraham, and he gave Sarra his woman back to him.

15 And Abimelech said to Abraham: Behold, my land is before you; dwell wherever may please you.

16 And to Sarra he said: Behold, I have given one thousand didrachmas to your brother; these shall be for you as honor of your face and for all the women with you; and speak truth in all things.

17 And Abraham prayed to God, and God healed Abimelech and his woman and his female servants, and they bore children;

18 because, shutting, the Lord shut every womb from outside in the house of Abimelech on account of Sarra, the woman of Abraham.

Chapter 21

1 And the Lord visited Sarra, just as he said, and the Lord did to Sarra just as he spoke,

2 and having conceived, Sarra bore a son for Abraham in his old age, at the time just as the Lord spoke to him.

3 And Abraham called the name of his son who came to be for him, whom Sarra bore for him, Isaac.

4 And Abraham circumcised Isaac on the eighth day, just as God commanded him.

5 And Abraham was one hundred years old when Isaac his son came to be for him.

6 And Sarra said: The Lord made laughter for me; for whoever may hear will rejoice with me.

7 And she said: Who will announce to Abraham that Sarra nurses a child? For I bore a son in my old age.

8 And the child grew and was weaned, and Abraham made a great reception on the day Isaac his son was weaned.

9 And Sarra saw the son of Agar the Egyptian, who came to be for Abraham, playing with Isaac her son,

10 and she said to Abraham: Cast out this female servant and her son, for the son of this female servant will not inherit with my son Isaac.

11 And the word appeared exceedingly hard before Abraham concerning his son.

12 And God said to Abraham: Let the word not be hard before you concerning the child and concerning the female servant. As many things as Sarra may say to you, listen to her voice, because in Isaac seed will be called for you.

13 And the son of this female servant also, I will make him into a great nation, because he is your seed.

14 And Abraham rose in the morning and took breads and a skin of water and gave them to Agar and placed them and the child upon her shoulder and sent her away. And having departed, she wandered in the wilderness by the Well of the Oath.

15 And the water failed from the skin, and she threw the child beneath one fir tree.

16 And having departed, she sat opposite him far away, about a bowshot, for she said: I shall certainly not see the death of my child. And she sat opposite him, and the child, crying aloud, wept.

17 And God listened to the voice of the child from the place where he was, and an angel of God called Agar from heaven and said to her: What is it, Agar? Do not be afraid, for God has heard the voice of your child from the place where he is.

18 Rise, take the child and hold him with your hand, for I will make him into a great nation.

19 And God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of living water and went and filled the skin with water and gave the child a drink.

20 And God was with the child, and he grew. And he dwelt in the wilderness and became an archer.

21 And he dwelt in the wilderness of Pharan, and his mother took a woman for him from the land of Egypt.

22 And it happened at that time that Abimelech and Ochozath his bride-conductor and Phicol the commander-in-chief of his force said to Abraham, saying: God is with you in all things which you may do.

23 Now therefore swear to me by God that you will not wrong me nor my seed nor my name, but according to the righteousness which I did with you, you will do with me and with the land in which you sojourned.

24 And Abraham said: I will swear.

25 And Abraham reproved Abimelech concerning the wells of water which Abimelech’s servants took away.

26 And Abimelech said to him: I did not know who did this thing, nor did you announce it to me, nor did I hear except today.

27 And Abraham took sheep and calves and gave them to Abimelech, and both made a covenant.

28 And Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the sheep alone.

29 And Abimelech said to Abraham: What are these seven ewe lambs of the sheep which you set alone?

30 And Abraham said: You shall take these seven ewe lambs from me so that they may be a testimony for me that I dug this well.

31 Because of this he named the name of that place Well of the Oath, because there both swore.

32 And they made a covenant at the Well of the Oath. And Abimelech and Ochozath his bride-conductor and Phicol the commander-in-chief of his force rose and returned into the land of the Phylistiim.

33 And Abraham planted a field at the Well of the Oath and there called upon the name of the Lord, Eternal God.

34 And Abraham sojourned in the land of the Phylistiim many days.

Chapter 22

1 And it happened after these words that God was testing Abraham and said to him: Abraham, Abraham. And he said: Behold, I am here.

2 And he said: Take your beloved son, whom you loved, Isaac, and go into the high land and offer him there as a whole burnt offering upon one of the mountains which I may tell you.

3 And Abraham rose in the morning and saddled his donkey; and he took with himself two servants and Isaac his son, and having split wood for a whole burnt offering, he rose and went and came to the place which God told him.

4 And on the third day Abraham looked up with his eyes and saw the place from far away.

5 And Abraham said to his servants: Sit here with the donkey, but I and the child will go through as far as there, and having worshiped, we will return to you.

6 And Abraham took the wood of the whole burnt offering and placed it upon Isaac his son; and he also took the fire in hand and the knife, and the two went together.

7 And Isaac spoke to Abraham his father, saying: Father. And he said: What is it, child? And he said: Behold, the fire and the wood; where is the sheep for a whole burnt offering?

8 And Abraham said: God will see for himself a sheep for a whole burnt offering, child. And both went together

9 and came to the place which God told him. And there Abraham built an altar and placed the wood, and having bound together the feet of Isaac his son, he placed him upon the altar above the wood.

10 And Abraham stretched out his hand to take the knife to slaughter his son.

11 And an angel of the Lord called him from heaven and said to him: Abraham, Abraham. And he said: Behold, I am here.

12 And he said: Do not lay your hand upon the child, nor do anything to him; for now I know that you fear God, you, and did not spare your beloved son because of me.

13 And Abraham looked up with his eyes and saw, and behold, one ram held in a plant Sabek by the horns. And Abraham went and took the ram and offered it as a whole burnt offering in place of Isaac his son.

14 And Abraham called the name of that place The Lord Saw, so that they may say today: In the mountain the Lord appeared.

15 And an angel of the Lord called Abraham a second time from heaven,

16 saying: By myself I swore, says the Lord, because you did this thing and did not spare your beloved son because of me,

17 surely indeed, blessing, I will bless you, and multiplying, I will multiply your seed like the stars of heaven and like the sand beside the lip of the sea, and your seed will inherit the cities of the adversaries.

18 And in your seed all the nations of the earth will be blessed, because you listened to my voice.

19 And Abraham returned to his servants, and rising, they went together to the Well of the Oath. And Abraham dwelt at the Well of the Oath.

20 And it happened after these words that it was announced to Abraham, saying: Behold, Melcha also has borne sons to Nachor your brother:

21 Ox the firstborn and Baux his brother and Kamouel the father of Syrians,

22 and Chasad and Azau and Phaldas and Jedlaph and Bathouel;

23 and Bathouel begot Rebekka. These are eight sons whom Melcha bore to Nachor, the brother of Abraham.

24 And his concubine, whose name was Rheuma, also bore Tabek and Gaam and Tochos and Mocha.

Chapter 23

1 And the life of Sarra was one hundred twenty-seven years.

2 And Sarra died in the city Arbok, which is in the hollow [this is Chebron], in the land of Chanaan. And Abraham came to lament Sarra and mourn.

3 And Abraham rose from his dead body and said to the sons of Chet, saying:

4 I am a sojourner and a stranger with you; therefore give me a possession for a tomb among you, and I will bury my dead away from me.

5 And the sons of Chet answered Abraham, saying:

6 No, lord; but hear us. You are a king from God among us; bury your dead in our chosen tombs, for no one of us will withhold his tomb from you so as to bury your dead there.

7 And Abraham rose and bowed to the people of the land, the sons of Chet,

8 and Abraham spoke to them, saying: If you have it in your soul that I bury my dead away from my face, hear me and speak concerning me to Ephron the son of Saar,

9 and let him give me the double cave which is his, which is at the edge of his field; for silver of its worth, let him give it to me among you as a possession for a tomb.

10 And Ephron was sitting in the midst of the sons of Chet; and Ephron the Chettite answered Abraham in the hearing of the sons of Chet and of all those entering into the city, saying:

11 Be with me, lord, and hear me. I give you the field and the cave which is in it; before all my fellow citizens I have given it to you. Bury your dead.

12 And Abraham bowed before the people of the land

13 and said to Ephron in the ears of the people of the land: Since you are for me, hear me; take the silver of the field from me, and I will bury my dead there.

14 And Ephron answered Abraham, saying:

15 No, lord; I have heard. Land worth four hundred didrachmas of silver—what might this be between me and you? But you, bury your dead.

16 And Abraham listened to Ephron, and Abraham paid Ephron the silver which he spoke in the ears of the sons of Chet, four hundred didrachmas of silver approved by merchants.

17 And the field of Ephron which was in the double cave, which is opposite Mamre, stood confirmed—the field and the cave which was in it and every tree which was in the field, which is within its boundaries all around—

18 as a possession for Abraham before the sons of Chet and all those entering into the city.

19 After these things Abraham buried Sarra his woman in the cave of the double field, which is opposite Mamre [this is Chebron], in the land of Chanaan.

20 And the field and the cave which was in it were confirmed for Abraham as a possession for a tomb from the sons of Chet.

Chapter 24

1 And Abraham was old, advanced in days, and the Lord blessed Abraham in all things.

2 And Abraham said to his servant, the elder of his house, who ruled all that was his: Place your hand under my thigh,

3 and I adjure you by the Lord, the God of heaven and the God of earth, that you do not take a woman for my son Isaac from the daughters of the Chananeans among whom I dwell,

4 but you shall go into my land, where I came to be, and into my tribe, and from there you shall take a woman for my son Isaac.

5 And the servant said to him: Perhaps the woman is not willing to go with me back into this land; shall I return your son into the land from where you came out?

6 And Abraham said to him: Attend to yourself, lest you return my son there.

7 The Lord, the God of heaven and the God of earth, who took me from the house of my father and from the land in which I was born, who spoke to me and swore to me, saying: To you and to your seed I will give this land—he will send his angel before you, and from there you shall take a woman for my son Isaac.

8 But if the woman is not willing to go with you into this land, you shall be clean from this oath; only do not return my son there.

9 And the servant placed his hand under the thigh of Abraham his lord and swore to him concerning this word.

10 And the servant took ten camels from the camels of his lord and some of all the good things of his lord with himself, and rising, he went into Mesopotamia, into the city of Nachor.

11 And he made the camels lie outside the city beside the well of water toward evening, when the women drawing water go out.

12 And he said: Lord, God of my lord Abraham, prosper me before you today and do mercy with my lord Abraham.

13 Behold, I am standing at the spring of water, and the daughters of those dwelling in the city are going out to draw water,

14 and it shall be that the maiden to whom I may say: Incline your jug so that I may drink, and she may say to me: Drink, and I will give your camels a drink until they cease drinking—this one you prepared for your servant Isaac, and by this I will know that you did mercy to my lord Abraham.

15 And it happened before he finished speaking in his mind that, behold, Rebekka came out, who was born to Bathouel, son of Melcha the woman of Nachor, the brother of Abraham, having the jug upon her shoulders.

16 And the maiden was exceedingly beautiful in appearance; she was a virgin, a man had not known her. And having descended to the spring, she filled the jug and came up.

17 And the servant ran to meet her and said: Give me a little water to drink from your jug.

18 And she said: Drink, lord. And she hurried and lowered the jug upon her arm and gave him a drink,

19 until he ceased drinking. And she said: I will also draw water for your camels until they all drink.

20 And she hurried and emptied the jug into the watering trough and ran again to the well to draw and drew water for all the camels.

21 And the man was studying her and remaining silent, to know whether the Lord had prospered his way or not.

22 And it happened when all the camels ceased drinking that the man took gold earrings, each a drachma in weight, and two bracelets for her hands, ten gold pieces in their weight.

23 And he questioned her and said: Whose daughter are you? Announce it to me. Is there a place with your father for us to lodge?

24 And she said to him: I am a daughter of Bathouel, the son of Melcha, whom she bore to Nachor.

25 And she said to him: There is both much straw and fodder with us, and a place to lodge.

26 And the man, being well pleased, worshiped the Lord

27 and said: Blessed is the Lord, the God of my lord Abraham, who did not forsake his righteousness and truth toward my lord. The Lord prospered me into the house of my lord’s brother.

28 And the girl ran and announced these words in the house of her mother.

29 And Rebekka had a brother whose name was Laban; and Laban ran outside to the man at the spring.

30 And it happened when he saw the earrings and the bracelets upon the hands of his sister, and when he heard the words of Rebekka his sister, saying: Thus the man spoke to me, that he came to the man as he was standing by the camels at the spring,

31 and said to him: Come, enter. Blessed is the Lord. Why are you standing outside? I have prepared the house and a place for the camels.

32 And the man entered into the house and unsaddled the camels. And he gave straw and fodder to the camels and water to wash his feet and the feet of the men with him.

33 And he set breads before them to eat. And he said: I shall certainly not eat until I speak my words. And they said: Speak.

34 And he said: I am a servant of Abraham.

35 And the Lord blessed my lord exceedingly, and he was exalted; and he gave him sheep and calves, silver and gold, male servants and female servants, camels and donkeys.

36 And Sarra, the woman of my lord, bore one son to my lord after he grew old, and he gave him as many things as were his.

37 And my lord made me swear, saying: You shall not take a woman for my son from the daughters of the Chananeans among whom I sojourn in their land,

38 but you shall go into the house of my father and into my tribe and from there take a woman for my son.

39 And I said to my lord: Perhaps the woman will not go with me.

40 And he said to me: The Lord, before whom I was well pleasing, will send his angel with you and prosper your way, and you shall take a woman for my son from my tribe and from the house of my father.

41 Then you shall be innocent from my curse; for whenever you come into my tribe and they do not give her to you, then you shall be innocent from my oath.

42 And coming today to the spring, I said: Lord, God of my lord Abraham, if you are prospering my way upon which I am now going,

43 behold, I am standing at the spring of water, and the daughters of the men of the city will go out to draw water, and it shall be that the maiden to whom I may say: Give me a little water to drink from your jug,

44 and she may say to me: You also drink, and I will draw water for your camels—this is the woman whom the Lord prepared for his own attendant Isaac, and by this I will know that you have done mercy to my lord Abraham.

45 And it happened before I finished speaking in my mind that immediately Rebekka came out, having the jug upon her shoulders, and went down to the spring and drew water. And I said to her: Give me a drink.

46 And hurrying, she lowered her jug from herself and said: You drink, and I will give your camels a drink. And I drank, and she gave my camels a drink.

47 And I asked her and said: Whose daughter are you? And she said: I am the daughter of Bathouel, the son of Nachor, whom Melcha bore to him. And I placed the earrings upon her and the bracelets around her hands.

48 And being well pleased, I worshiped the Lord and blessed the Lord, the God of my lord Abraham, who prospered me in a way of truth, to take the daughter of my lord’s brother for his son.

49 If therefore you are doing mercy and righteousness toward my lord, announce it to me; but if not, announce it to me, so that I may turn to the right or to the left.

50 And Laban and Bathouel answered and said: This command came out from the Lord; therefore we will not be able to speak against you, evil for good.

51 Behold, Rebekka is before you; take her and run away, and let her be a woman for your lord’s son, just as the Lord spoke.

52 And it happened when the servant of Abraham heard these words that he worshiped the Lord upon the earth.

53 And the servant brought out vessels of silver and gold and clothing and gave them to Rebekka, and he gave gifts to her brother and her mother.

54 And he and the men who were with him ate and drank and lay down. And rising in the morning, he said: Send me out, so that I may depart to my lord.

55 But her brothers and her mother said: Let the maiden remain with us about ten days, and after these things she will depart.

56 But he said to them: Do not hold me back, and the Lord has prospered my way; send me out, so that I may depart to my lord.

57 And they said: Let us call the girl and ask her mouth.

58 And they called Rebekka and said to her: Will you go with this man? And she said: I will go.

59 And they sent out Rebekka their sister and her possessions and the servant of Abraham and those with him.

60 And they blessed Rebekka their sister and said to her: You are our sister; become thousands of myriads, and let your seed inherit the cities of the adversaries.

61 And Rebekka and her maidens rose and mounted the camels and went with the man, and the servant took Rebekka and departed.

62 And Isaac was journeying through the wilderness by the Well of the Vision; and he dwelt in the land toward the southwest.

63 And Isaac went out to meditate in the field toward evening, and looking up with his eyes, he saw camels coming.

64 And Rebekka, looking up with her eyes, saw Isaac and jumped down from the camel

65 and said to the servant: Who is that man journeying in the field to meet us? And the servant said: He is my lord. And she took the veil and wrapped herself.

66 And the servant recounted to Isaac all the things which he did.

67 And Isaac entered into the house of his mother and took Rebekka, and she became his woman, and he loved her; and Isaac was comforted concerning Sarra his mother.

Chapter 25

1 And Abraham, in addition, took a woman whose name was Chettoura.

2 And she bore him Zemran and Jexan and Madan and Madiam and Jesbok and Soue.

3 And Jexan begot Saba and Thaiman and Daidan; and the sons of Daidan came to be Ragouel and Nabdeel and Assouriim and Latousiim and Loomim.

4 And the sons of Madiam: Gaipha and Apher and Enoch and Abira and Elraga. All these were sons of Chettoura.

5 And Abraham gave all his possessions to Isaac his son,

6 and Abraham gave gifts to the sons of his concubines and sent them away from Isaac his son while he was still living, toward the east, into a land of the east.

7 And these are the years of the days of Abraham’s life, as many as he lived: one hundred seventy-five years.

8 And failing, Abraham died in a good old age, old and full of days, and was added to his people.

9 And Isaac and Ismael his sons buried him in the double cave, in the field of Ephron the son of Saar the Chettite, which is opposite Mamre,

10 the field and the cave which Abraham acquired from the sons of Chet; there they buried Abraham and Sarra his woman.

11 And it happened after Abraham died that God blessed Isaac his son; and Isaac dwelt beside the Well of the Vision.

12 Now these are the generations of Ismael the son of Abraham, whom Agar the female servant of Sarra bore for Abraham,

13 and these are the names of the sons of Ismael, by name according to his generations: the firstborn of Ismael, Nabaioth, and Kedar and Nabdeel and Massam,

14 and Masma and Idouma and Masse,

15 and Choddad and Thaiman and Jetour and Naphes and Kedma.

16 These are the sons of Ismael, and these are their names in their tents and in their settlements: twelve rulers according to their nations.

17 And these are the years of the life of Ismael: one hundred thirty-seven years; and failing, he died and was added to his race.

18 And he dwelt from Evilat as far as Sour, which is opposite Egypt, until coming toward the Assyrians; before the face of all his brothers he dwelt.

19 And these are the generations of Isaac the son of Abraham. Abraham begot Isaac.

20 And Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekka, daughter of Bathouel the Syrian from Mesopotamia and sister of Laban the Syrian, as a woman for himself.

21 And Isaac entreated the Lord concerning Rebekka his woman, because she was barren; and God listened to him, and Rebekka his woman conceived.

22 And the children were leaping within her; and she said: If it is going to be thus for me, why is this to me? And she went to inquire from the Lord,

23 and the Lord said to her: Two nations are in your womb, and two peoples will be separated from your belly; and a people will surpass a people, and the greater will serve the lesser.

24 And the days for her to give birth were fulfilled, and behold, there were twins in her belly.

25 And the firstborn son came out reddish, all hairy like a hide; and he named his name Esau.

26 And after this his brother came out, and his hand was holding the heel of Esau; and he called his name Jacob. And Isaac was sixty years old when Rebekka bore them.

27 And the young men grew, and Esau was a man knowing how to hunt, a rustic, but Jacob was a simple man dwelling in a house.

28 And Isaac loved Esau, because his game was food for him; but Rebekka loved Jacob.

29 And Jacob boiled a boiled dish; and Esau came from the field, failing,

30 and Esau said to Jacob: Give me a taste from this red boiled dish, because I am failing. Because of this his name was called Edom.

31 And Jacob said to Esau: Give me your birthright today.

32 And Esau said: Behold, I am going to die, and why is this birthright for me?

33 And Jacob said to him: Swear to me today. And he swore to him; and Esau gave the birthright to Jacob.

34 And Jacob gave Esau bread and a boiled dish of lentils, and he ate and drank and rose and went away; and Esau treated the birthright as worthless.

Chapter 26

1 And a famine came upon the land besides the former famine which came in the time of Abraham; and Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Phylistiim in Gerara.

2 And the Lord appeared to him and said: Do not go down into Egypt; but dwell in the land which I may tell you.

3 And sojourn in this land, and I will be with you and bless you; for to you and to your seed I will give all this land, and I will establish my oath which I swore to Abraham your father.

4 And I will multiply your seed like the stars of heaven and give to your seed all this land, and in your seed all the nations of the earth will be blessed,

5 because Abraham your father listened to my voice and guarded my directives and my commandments and my ordinances and my laws.

6 And Isaac dwelt in Gerara.

7 And the men of the place questioned him concerning Rebekka his woman, and he said: She is my sister, for he was afraid to say: She is my woman, lest the men of the place kill him concerning Rebekka, because she was beautiful in appearance.

8 And he spent a long time there; and Abimelech king of Gerara, peering through the window, saw Isaac playing with Rebekka his woman.

9 And Abimelech called Isaac and said to him: Then indeed she is your woman; why is it that you said: She is my sister? And Isaac said to him: For I said: Lest I die because of her.

10 And Abimelech said to him: What is this you did to us? One of my race almost lay with your woman, and you brought ignorance upon us.

11 And Abimelech commanded all his people, saying: Everyone who touches this man or his woman will be liable to death.

12 And Isaac sowed in that land and found in that year barley bearing a hundredfold; and the Lord blessed him.

13 And the man was exalted and, proceeding, became greater until he became exceedingly great.

14 And he came to have livestock of sheep and livestock of cattle and much agriculture. And the Phylistiim envied him,

15 and all the wells which the servants of his father dug in the time of his father, the Phylistiim stopped them and filled them with earth.

16 And Abimelech said to Isaac: Depart from us, because you became exceedingly more powerful than we.

17 And Isaac departed from there and lodged in the ravine of Gerara and dwelt there.

18 And again Isaac dug the wells of water which the servants of Abraham his father dug and the Phylistiim stopped after Abraham his father died, and he named names for them according to the names which Abraham his father named.

19 And the servants of Isaac dug in the ravine of Gerara and found there a well of living water.

20 And the shepherds of Gerara fought with the shepherds of Isaac, asserting that the water was theirs; and he called the name of the well Injustice, for they wronged him.

21 And Isaac departed from there and dug another well, and they also disputed concerning that one; and he named its name Enmity.

22 And he departed from there and dug another well, and they did not fight concerning it; and he named its name Broad Place, saying: Because now the Lord has widened for us and increased us upon the earth.

23 And he went up from there to the Well of the Oath.

24 And the Lord appeared to him on that night and said: I am the God of Abraham your father. Do not be afraid, for I am with you and have blessed you, and I will multiply your seed because of Abraham your father.

25 And he built an altar there and called upon the name of the Lord and pitched his tent there; and the servants of Isaac dug a well there.

26 And Abimelech went to him from Gerara, and Ochozath his bride-conductor and Phicol the commander-in-chief of his force.

27 And Isaac said to them: Why did you come to me? But you hated me and sent me away from you.

28 And they said: Seeing, we have seen that the Lord was with you, and we said: Let a curse come to be between us and between you, and we will make a covenant with you,

29 that you will not do evil with us, since we did not abhor you, and in the manner that we treated you well and sent you away with peace. And now you are blessed by the Lord.

30 And he made a reception for them, and they ate and drank.

31 And rising in the morning, a man swore to his neighbor, and Isaac sent them away, and they departed from him with safety.

32 And it happened on that day that the servants of Isaac arrived and announced to him concerning the well which they dug, and they said: We did not find water.

33 And he called it Oath; because of this the name of the city is Well of the Oath until today.

34 And Esau was forty years old and took as a woman Joudin the daughter of Beer the Chettite and Basemmath the daughter of Ailon the Evaean.

35 And they were quarreling with Isaac and Rebekka.

Chapter 27

1 And it happened after Isaac grew old and his eyes were dulled from seeing that he called Esau his elder son and said to him: My son. And he said: Behold, I am here.

2 And he said: Behold, I have grown old and do not know the day of my end.

3 Now therefore take your equipment, both the quiver and the bow, and go out into the field and hunt game for me,

4 and make delicacies for me, as I love, and bring them to me so that I may eat, that my soul may bless you before I die.

5 And Rebekka heard Isaac speaking to Esau his son. And Esau went into the field to hunt game for his father.

6 And Rebekka said to Jacob her lesser son: See, I heard your father speaking to Esau your brother, saying:

7 Bring me game and make delicacies for me, and having eaten, I will bless you before the Lord before I die.

8 Now therefore, son, listen to me, according to the things which I command you,

9 and having gone to the sheep, take for me from there two tender and good kids, and I will make them into delicacies for your father, as he loves,

10 and you shall bring them in to your father, and he will eat, so that your father may bless you before he dies.

11 And Jacob said to Rebekka his mother: Esau my brother is a hairy man, but I am a smooth man.

12 Perhaps my father will feel me, and I will be before him as one treating him with contempt, and I will bring a curse upon myself and not a blessing.

13 And his mother said to him: Your curse be upon me, child; only listen to my voice, and having gone, bring them to me.

14 And having gone, he took and brought them to his mother, and his mother made delicacies just as his father loved.

15 And Rebekka took the good robe of Esau her elder son, which was with her in the house, and clothed Jacob her younger son,

16 and she placed the skins of the kids upon his arms and upon the bare parts of his neck,

17 and she gave the delicacies and the breads which she made into the hands of Jacob her son.

18 And he brought them in to his father. And he said: Father. And he said: Behold, I am here. Who are you, child?

19 And Jacob said to his father: I am Esau your firstborn. I did just as you spoke to me. Rise, sit and eat from my game, so that your soul may bless me.

20 And Isaac said to his son: What is this which you found quickly, O child? And he said: That which the Lord your God delivered before me.

21 And Isaac said to Jacob: Draw near to me, and I will feel you, child, whether you are my son Esau or not.

22 And Jacob drew near to Isaac his father, and he felt him and said: The voice is the voice of Jacob, but the hands are the hands of Esau.

23 And he did not recognize him, for his hands were hairy like the hands of Esau his brother; and he blessed him.

24 And he said: Are you my son Esau? And he said: I am.

25 And he said: Bring it near to me, and I will eat from your game, child, so that my soul may bless you. And he brought it near to him, and he ate; and he brought wine in to him, and he drank.

26 And Isaac his father said to him: Draw near to me and kiss me, child.

27 And drawing near, he kissed him, and he smelled the scent of his garments and blessed him and said: Behold, the scent of my son is like the scent of a full field which the Lord blessed.

28 And may God give you from the dew of heaven and from the richness of the earth and a multitude of grain and wine.

29 And let nations serve you, and rulers will bow to you; and become lord of your brother, and the sons of your father will bow to you. The one cursing you is accursed, but the one blessing you is blessed.

30 And it happened after Isaac ceased blessing Jacob his son, and it happened as Jacob went out from the face of Isaac his father, that Esau his brother came from the hunt.

31 And he also made delicacies and brought them to his father and said to his father: Let my father rise and eat from the game of his son, so that your soul may bless me.

32 And Isaac his father said to him: Who are you? And he said: I am your firstborn son Esau.

33 And Isaac was astonished with exceedingly great astonishment and said: Who then is the one who hunted game for me and brought it in to me? And I ate from all before you came and blessed him, and let him be blessed.

34 And it happened when Esau heard the words of Isaac his father that he cried out with an exceedingly great and bitter voice and said: Bless me also, father.

35 And he said to him: Your brother came with deceit and took your blessing.

36 And he said: Rightly was his name called Jacob, for he has heeled me already, this second time; he has taken both my birthright and now my blessing. And Esau said to his father: Did you not leave a blessing for me, father?

37 And Isaac answered and said to Esau: If I made him your lord and made all his brothers his household servants and supported him with grain and wine, then what shall I do for you, child?

38 And Esau said to his father: Is there only one blessing with you, father? Bless me also, father. And when Isaac was pierced, Esau cried aloud and wept.

39 And Isaac his father answered and said to him: Behold, from the richness of the earth shall your dwelling be, and from the dew of heaven above.

40 And upon your sword you shall live, and you shall serve your brother; but it will be that whenever you take him down, you will loosen his yoke from your neck.

41 And Esau held a grudge against Jacob concerning the blessing with which his father blessed him; and Esau said in his mind: Let the days of mourning for my father draw near, so that I may kill Jacob my brother.

42 And the words of Esau her elder son were announced to Rebekka, and sending, she called Jacob her younger son and said to him: Behold, Esau your brother threatens you, to kill you.

43 Now therefore, child, listen to my voice and rise and flee into Mesopotamia to Laban my brother, into Charran,

44 and dwell with him some days until the wrath

45 and the anger of your brother turn away from you, and he forgets the things you have done to him, and sending, I will summon you from there, lest I be made childless from both of you in one day.

46 And Rebekka said to Isaac: I am vexed with my life because of the daughters of the sons of Chet; if Jacob takes a woman from the daughters of this land, why should I live?

Chapter 28

1 And Isaac summoned Jacob and blessed him and commanded him, saying: You shall not take a woman from the daughters of Chanaan.

2 Rise and flee into Mesopotamia, into the house of Bathouel the father of your mother, and take for yourself from there a woman from the daughters of Laban, your mother’s brother.

3 And may my God bless you and increase you and multiply you, and you shall become congregations of nations.

4 And may he give you the blessing of Abraham my father, to you and to your seed after you, to inherit the land of your sojourning which God gave to Abraham.

5 And Isaac sent Jacob away, and he went into Mesopotamia to Laban the son of Bathouel the Syrian, the brother of Rebekka, the mother of Jacob and Esau.

6 And Esau saw that Isaac blessed Jacob and that he went away into Mesopotamia of Syria to take for himself a woman from there, and that when he blessed him he commanded him, saying: You shall not take a woman from the daughters of Chanaan,

7 and that Jacob listened to his father and his mother and went into Mesopotamia of Syria.

8 And Esau saw that the daughters of Chanaan were evil before Isaac his father,

9 and Esau went to Ismael and took Maeleth, daughter of Ismael the son of Abraham and sister of Nabaioth, in addition to his women, as a woman.

10 And Jacob went out from the Well of the Oath and went into Charran.

11 And he met a place and slept there, for the sun set; and he took from the stones of the place and placed one toward his head and slept in that place.

12 And he dreamed, and behold, a ladder fixed in the earth, whose head reached into heaven, and the angels of God were ascending and descending upon it.

13 And the Lord had stood upon it and said: I am the Lord, the God of Abraham your father and the God of Isaac. Do not be afraid. The land upon which you sleep, I will give it to you and to your seed.

14 And your seed will be like the sand of the earth and will be broadened toward the sea and toward the southwest and toward the north and toward the east, and in you all the tribes of the earth will be blessed, and in your seed.

15 And behold, I am with you, guarding you throughout every way wherever you may go, and I will return you into this land, because I shall certainly not abandon you until I do all the things which I spoke to you.

16 And Jacob awoke from his sleep and said: The Lord is in this place, but I did not know.

17 And he was afraid and said: How fearsome is this place. This is none other than a house of God, and this is the gate of heaven.

18 And Jacob rose in the morning and took the stone which he placed there toward his head and set it as a pillar and poured oil upon its top.

19 And Jacob called the name of that place House of God; and Oulamlous was formerly the name of the city.

20 And Jacob vowed a vow, saying: If the Lord God is with me and guards me on this way which I am going and gives me bread to eat and a garment to put around myself,

21 and returns me with safety into the house of my father, then the Lord shall be God for me,

22 and this stone which I set as a pillar shall be a house of God for me, and of all the things which you may give me, I will tithe a tenth of them to you.

Chapter 29

1 And Jacob, lifting his feet, went into a land of the east toward Laban the son of Bathouel the Syrian, the brother of Rebekka, mother of Jacob and Esau.

2 And he sees, and behold, a well in the plain, and there were three flocks of sheep resting upon it; for from that well they gave the flocks a drink, and there was a large stone upon the mouth of the well.

3 And all the flocks would be gathered there, and they would roll the stone from the mouth of the well and give the sheep a drink and restore the stone upon the mouth of the well to its place.

4 And Jacob said to them: Brothers, from where are you? And they said: We are from Charran.

5 And he said to them: Do you know Laban the son of Nachor? And they said: We know him.

6 And he said to them: Is he healthy? And they said: He is healthy. And behold, Rachel his daughter was coming with the sheep.

7 And Jacob said: There is still much day; it is not yet time for the cattle to be gathered. Give the sheep a drink and depart and pasture them.

8 And they said: We will not be able until all the shepherds are gathered and they roll the stone from the mouth of the well, and then we will give the sheep a drink.

9 While he was still speaking to them, Rachel the daughter of Laban was also coming with the sheep of her father, for she pastured the sheep of her father.

10 And it happened when Jacob saw Rachel, daughter of Laban the brother of his mother, and the sheep of Laban the brother of his mother, that Jacob drew near and rolled the stone from the mouth of the well and gave the sheep of Laban, the brother of his mother, a drink.

11 And Jacob kissed Rachel and, crying out with his voice, wept.

12 And he announced to Rachel that he was the brother of her father and that he was a son of Rebekka, and running, she announced these words to her father.

13 And it happened when Laban heard the name of Jacob, the son of his sister, that he ran to meet him and embraced him and kissed him and brought him into his house. And he recounted to Laban all these words.

14 And Laban said to him: You are from my bones and from my flesh. And he was with him a month of days.

15 And Laban said to Jacob: Because you are my brother, you will not serve me for nothing; announce to me what your wage is.

16 And Laban had two daughters; the name of the elder was Leia, and the name of the younger Rachel.

17 And the eyes of Leia were weak, but Rachel was beautiful in form and lovely in appearance.

18 And Jacob loved Rachel and said: I will serve you seven years for Rachel your younger daughter.

19 And Laban said to him: It is better for me to give her to you than for me to give her to another man; dwell with me.

20 And Jacob served seven years for Rachel, and they were before him like a few days because of his loving her. –

21 And Jacob said to Laban: Give back my woman, for my days have been fulfilled, so that I may go in to her.

22 And Laban gathered all the men of the place and made a wedding.

23 And evening came, and Laban took Leia his daughter and brought her in to Jacob, and Jacob went in to her.

24 And Laban gave Zelpha his female servant to Leia his daughter as her female servant.

25 And morning came, and behold, it was Leia. And Jacob said to Laban: What is this you did to me? Did I not serve with you for Rachel? And why did you deceive me?

26 And Laban said: It is not thus in our place, to give the younger before the elder.

27 Therefore complete the seven days of this one, and I will also give you this one in exchange for the labor which you will work with me for yet another seven years.

28 And Jacob did thus and completed the seven days of this one, and Laban gave him Rachel his daughter as his woman.

29 And Laban gave Balla his female servant to Rachel his daughter as her female servant.

30 And he went in to Rachel; and he loved Rachel more than Leia, and he served him another seven years.

31 And the Lord, seeing that Leia was hated, opened her womb; but Rachel was barren.

32 And Leia conceived and bore a son to Jacob; and she called his name Rouben, saying: Because the Lord saw my humiliation; now my man will love me.

33 And Leia conceived again and bore a second son to Jacob and said: Because the Lord heard that I am hated, he also gave me this one; and she called his name Symeon.

34 And she conceived yet again and bore a son and said: At the present time my man will be toward me, for I bore him three sons; because of this she called his name Levi.

35 And conceiving yet again, she bore a son and said: Now yet this time I will acknowledge the Lord; because of this she called his name Juda. And she stopped bearing.

Chapter 30

1 And Rachel, seeing that she had not borne for Jacob, envied her sister and said to Jacob: Give me children; but if not, I will come to an end.

2 And Jacob became angry with Rachel and said to her: Am I in place of God, who deprived you of fruit of the belly?

3 And Rachel said to Jacob: Behold, my female servant Balla; go in to her, and she will bear upon my knees, and I also will have children from her.

4 And she gave him Balla her female servant as a woman for him; and Jacob went in to her.

5 And Balla the female servant of Rachel conceived and bore a son to Jacob.

6 And Rachel said: God judged for me and listened to my voice and gave me a son; because of this she called his name Dan.

7 And Balla the female servant of Rachel conceived yet again and bore a second son to Jacob.

8 And Rachel said: God helped me, and I joined in contest with my sister and prevailed; and she called his name Nephthali.

9 And Leia saw that she stopped bearing, and she took Zelpha her female servant and gave her to Jacob as a woman.

10 And Jacob went in to her, and Zelpha the female servant of Leia conceived and bore a son to Jacob.

11 And Leia said: In fortune; and she named his name Gad.

12 And Zelpha the female servant of Leia conceived and bore yet a second son to Jacob.

13 And Leia said: Blessed am I, because the women call me blessed; and she called his name Aser.

14 And Rouben went in the days of the wheat harvest and found mandrake apples in the field and brought them to Leia his mother. And Rachel said to Leia: Give me some of your son’s mandrakes.

15 And Leia said: Is it not enough for you that you took my man? Will you also take the mandrakes of my son? And Rachel said: Not so; let him lie with you this night in exchange for the mandrakes of your son.

16 And Jacob entered from the field at evening, and Leia went out to meet him and said: You shall come in to me today, for I have hired you in exchange for the mandrakes of my son. And he lay with her that night.

17 And God listened to Leia, and conceiving, she bore a fifth son to Jacob.

18 And Leia said: God gave my wage in return for my giving my female servant to my man; and she called his name Issachar, which is Wage.

19 And Leia conceived yet again and bore a sixth son to Jacob.

20 And Leia said: God has given me a good gift; at the present time my man will choose me, for I bore him six sons. And she called his name Zaboulon.

21 And after this she bore a daughter and called her name Dina.

22 And God remembered Rachel, and God listened to her and opened her womb,

23 and conceiving, she bore a son to Jacob. And Rachel said: My God removed my reproach;

24 and she called his name Joseph, saying: May God add another son for me.

25 And it happened when Rachel bore Joseph that Jacob said to Laban: Send me away, so that I may depart into my place and into my land.

26 Give back my women and the children for whom I have served you, so that I may depart; for you know the service which I have served you.

27 And Laban said to him: If I found grace before you, I would have divined; for God blessed me at your entrance.

28 Specify your wage to me, and I will give it.

29 And Jacob said to him: You know the things for which I have served you and how many of your cattle were with me;

30 for the things which were yours before me were few, and they increased into a multitude, and the Lord blessed you at my foot. Now therefore, when will I also make a house for myself?

31 And Laban said to him: What shall I give you? And Jacob said to him: You shall give me nothing. If you do this thing for me, I will again shepherd your sheep and guard them.

32 Let all your sheep pass today, and separate from there every gray sheep among the lambs and every white-spotted and speckled one among the goats; it shall be my wage.

33 And my righteousness will answer for me on the day tomorrow, because my wage is before you: every one which is not speckled and white-spotted among the goats and gray among the lambs will be stolen if found with me.

34 And Laban said to him: Let it be according to your word.

35 And on that day he separated the speckled and white-spotted male goats and all the speckled and white-spotted female goats and every one which had white in them and every one which was gray among the lambs, and he gave them by the hand of his sons.

36 And he set a journey of three days between them and between Jacob; and Jacob shepherded the remaining sheep of Laban. –

37 And Jacob took for himself green rods of storax and walnut and plane tree, and Jacob peeled them with white peelings, stripping off the green; and the white which he peeled appeared variegated upon the rods.

38 And he placed the rods which he peeled in the troughs of the watering basins, so that whenever the sheep came to drink before the rods, when they came to drink,

39 the sheep might conceive at the rods; and the sheep bore white-spotted and variegated and ash-colored speckled young.

40 And Jacob separated the lambs and set before the sheep a white-spotted ram and every variegated one among the lambs; and he separated flocks for himself by themselves and did not mix them with the sheep of Laban.

41 And it happened at the time when the sheep that were becoming pregnant conceived that Jacob placed the rods before the sheep in the troughs, so that they might conceive by the rods.

42 But whenever the sheep bore, he did not place them; and the unmarked became Laban’s, but the marked Jacob’s.

43 And the man became exceedingly, exceedingly rich, and he came to have many cattle and cattle and male servants and female servants and camels and donkeys.

Chapter 31

1 And Jacob heard the words of Laban’s sons, saying: Jacob has taken all the things of our father, and from the things of our father he has made all this glory.

2 And Jacob saw the face of Laban, and behold, it was not toward him as yesterday and the third day.

3 And the Lord said to Jacob: Return into the land of your father and into your generation, and I will be with you.

4 And Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leia into the field where the flocks were,

5 and said to them: I see the face of your father, that it is not toward me as yesterday and the third day; but the God of my father was with me.

6 And you yourselves know that I have served your father with all my strength.

7 But your father deceived me and changed my wage of ten lambs, and God did not permit him to harm me.

8 If he would say thus: The variegated shall be your wage, then all the sheep would bear variegated young; but if he would say: The white shall be your wage, then all the sheep would bear white young.

9 And God took away all the cattle of your father and gave them to me.

10 And it happened when the sheep were conceiving that I saw them with my eyes in sleep, and behold, the male goats and the rams mounting the sheep and the female goats were white-spotted and variegated and ash-colored speckled.

11 And the angel of God said to me in sleep: Jacob. And I said: What is it?

12 And he said: Look up with your eyes and see the male goats and the rams mounting the sheep and the female goats, white-spotted and variegated and ash-colored speckled, for I have seen as many things as Laban is doing to you.

13 I am God who appeared to you in Place of God, where you anointed a pillar for me and vowed a vow to me. Now therefore rise and go out from this land and depart into the land of your birth, and I will be with you.

14 And Rachel and Leia answered and said to him: Is there still a portion or inheritance for us in the house of our father?

15 Have we not been regarded by him as foreigners? For he sold us and devoured our silver with devouring.

16 All the wealth and the glory which God took away from our father shall be for us and for our children. Now therefore do as many things as God has said to you.

17 And Jacob rose and took his women and his children upon the camels,

18 and led away all his possessions and all his baggage which he acquired in Mesopotamia, and all that was his, to depart to Isaac his father in the land of Chanaan.

19 And Laban had gone to shear his sheep; and Rachel stole the idols of her father.

20 And Jacob concealed from Laban the Syrian by not announcing to him that he was fleeing,

21 and he fled, he and all that was his, and crossed the river and rushed toward the mountain Galaad.

22 And it was announced to Laban the Syrian on the third day that Jacob had fled,

23 and taking all his brothers with himself, he pursued after him a journey of seven days and overtook him at the mountain Galaad.

24 And God came to Laban the Syrian in sleep at night and said to him: Guard yourself, lest you speak evil things with Jacob.

25 And Laban overtook Jacob; and Jacob pitched his tent in the mountain, but Laban stationed his brothers in the mountain Galaad.

26 And Laban said to Jacob: What did you do? Why did you secretly flee and carry me off by theft and lead away my daughters like captives of the sword?

27 And if you had announced it to me, I would have sent you away with gladness and with music, drums and lyre.

28 I was not deemed worthy to kiss my children and my daughters. But now you acted senselessly.

29 And now my hand has strength to harm you; but the God of your father spoke to me yesterday, saying: Guard yourself, lest you speak evil things with Jacob.

30 Now therefore you have gone, for with desire you desired to depart into the house of your father; why did you steal my gods?

31 And Jacob answered and said to Laban: For I said: Lest you take your daughters away from me, and all that is mine.

32 Recognize what of yours is with me and take it. And he did not recognize anything with him. And Jacob said to him: With whomever you may find your gods, he shall not live before our brothers. But Jacob did not know that Rachel his woman stole them.

33 And Laban entered and searched the house of Leia and did not find them; and going out from the house of Leia, he searched the house of Jacob and the house of the two female servants and did not find them. And he also entered into the house of Rachel.

34 But Rachel took the idols and put them into the saddles of the camel and sat upon them.

35 And she said to her father: Do not bear it heavily, lord; I am not able to rise before you, because the custom of women is mine. And Laban searched in the whole house and did not find the idols.

36 And Jacob became angry and fought with Laban; and Jacob answered and said to Laban: What is my injustice and what is my sin, that you pursued after me

37 and searched all my vessels? What did you find from all the vessels of your house? Place it here before my brothers and your brothers, and let them expose what is between the two of us.

38 These twenty years I have been with you; your sheep and your female goats did not become childless; the rams of your sheep I did not eat.

39 What was caught by a beast I did not bring to you; I paid from myself the thefts of day and the thefts of night.

40 By day I was scorched by heat and by night by frost, and sleep departed from my eyes.

41 These twenty years I have been in your house; I served you fourteen years in exchange for your two daughters and six years among your sheep, and you deceived me concerning my wage by ten lambs.

42 If the God of my father Abraham and the Fear of Isaac had not been for me, now you would have sent me away empty. God saw my humiliation and the toil of my hands and rebuked you yesterday.

43 And Laban answered and said to Jacob: The daughters are my daughters, and the sons my sons, and the cattle my cattle, and all the things which you see are mine and my daughters'. What shall I do to these today, or to their children whom they bore?

44 Now therefore come, let us make a covenant, I and you, and it shall be a testimony between me and you. And he said to him: Behold, no one is with us; see, God is witness between me and you.

45 And Jacob took a stone and set it as a pillar.

46 And Jacob said to his brothers: Gather stones. And they gathered stones and made a mound, and ate and drank there upon the mound. And Laban said to him: This mound testifies between me and you today.

47 And Laban called it Mound of the Testimony, but Jacob called it Mound Witness.

48 And Laban said to Jacob: Behold, this mound and this pillar which I set between me and you; this mound testifies and this pillar testifies. Because of this its name was called Mound Testifies,

49 and The Vision, of which he said: May God look between me and you, because we will depart from one another.

50 If you humiliate my daughters, if you take women in addition to my daughters, see, no one is with us.

52 For if I do not cross toward you, nor you cross toward me, this mound and this pillar for evil,

53 the God of Abraham and the God of Nachor will judge between us. And Jacob swore by the Fear of his father Isaac.

54 And Jacob sacrificed a sacrifice in the mountain and called his brothers, and they ate and drank and slept in the mountain.

Chapter 32

1 And Laban rose in the morning and kissed his sons and his daughters and blessed them, and Laban turned and departed to his place.

2 And Jacob departed on his own way. And looking up, he saw an encampment of God encamped, and the angels of God met him.

3 And Jacob said when he saw them: This is an encampment of God; and he called the name of that place Encampments.

4 And Jacob sent messengers before him to Esau his brother, into the land Seir, into the country Edom,

5 and commanded them, saying: Thus you shall say to my lord Esau: Thus says your servant Jacob: I sojourned with Laban and delayed until now,

6 and I came to have cattle and donkeys and sheep and male servants and female servants, and I sent to announce it to my lord Esau, so that your servant may find grace before you.

7 And the messengers returned to Jacob, saying: We came to your brother Esau, and behold, he is coming to meet you, and four hundred men with him.

8 And Jacob was exceedingly afraid and perplexed. And he divided the people with him and the cattle and the sheep into two encampments,

9 and Jacob said: If Esau comes into one encampment and cuts it down, then the second encampment will be for being saved.

10 And Jacob said: God of my father Abraham and God of my father Isaac, Lord who said to me: Run away into the land of your birth, and I will do you good,

11 it is enough for me from all the righteousness and from all the truth which you did for your servant; for with my staff I crossed this Jordan, but now I have become two encampments.

12 Deliver me from the hand of my brother Esau, because I am afraid of him, lest he come and strike me and mother upon children.

13 But you said: Well, I will do you good and make your seed like the sand of the sea, which will not be numbered because of the multitude.

14 And he slept there that night. And he took from the things he was carrying as gifts and sent them to Esau his brother:

15 two hundred female goats, twenty male goats, two hundred sheep, twenty rams,

16 thirty nursing camels and their children, forty cattle, ten bulls, twenty female donkeys and ten foals.

17 And he gave each flock separately by the hand to his servants. And he said to his servants: Go before me and make a space between flock and flock.

18 And he commanded the first, saying: If Esau my brother meets you and asks you, saying: Whose are you, and where are you going, and whose are these things going before you?

19 You shall say: They are your servant Jacob’s; he has sent gifts to my lord Esau, and behold, he is behind us.

20 And he commanded the first and the second and the third and all those going behind these flocks, saying: According to this word speak to Esau when you find him,

21 and you shall say: Behold, your servant Jacob is arriving behind us. For he said: I will propitiate his face with the gifts going before his face, and after this I will see his face, for perhaps he will accept my face.

22 And the gifts were passing before his face, but he slept that night in the encampment.

23 And rising that night, he took his two women and the two female servants and his eleven children and crossed the crossing of Jabok.

24 And he took them and crossed the torrent and caused all that was his to cross.

25 And Jacob was left alone, and a man was wrestling with him until morning.

26 And he saw that he was not able against him, and touched the breadth of his thigh, and the breadth of Jacob’s thigh became numb while he wrestled with him.

27 And he said to him: Send me away, for dawn has risen. But he said: I shall certainly not send you away unless you bless me.

28 And he said to him: What is your name? And he said: Jacob.

29 And he said to him: Your name shall no longer be called Jacob, but Israel shall be your name, because you were strong with God and powerful with men.

30 And Jacob asked and said: Announce your name to me. And he said: Why is it that you ask my name? And he blessed him there.

31 And Jacob called the name of that place Appearance of God; for I saw God face to face, and my soul was saved.

32 And the sun rose upon him when he passed the Appearance of God; and he was limping on his thigh.

33 Because of this the sons of Israel certainly do not eat the sinew which became numb, which is upon the breadth of the thigh, until this day, because he touched the breadth of Jacob’s thigh, the sinew, and it became numb.

Chapter 33

1 And Jacob looked up and saw, and behold, Esau his brother was coming, and four hundred men with him. And Jacob further divided the children among Leia and Rachel and the two female servants.

2 And he placed the two female servants and their sons first, and Leia and her children behind, and Rachel and Joseph last.

3 But he himself went ahead before them and bowed down upon the ground seven times, until he drew near to his brother.

4 And Esau ran to meet him, and embracing him, he kissed him and fell upon his neck; and both wept.

5 And looking up, he saw the women and the children and said: What are these to you? And he said: The children with whom God had mercy on your servant.

6 And the female servants and their children drew near and bowed down.

7 And Leia and her children drew near and bowed down; and after these Rachel and Joseph drew near and bowed down.

8 And he said: What are all these encampments to you, which I met? And he said: That your servant may find grace before you, lord.

9 And Esau said: I have plenty, brother; let what is yours be yours.

10 And Jacob said: If I have found grace before you, receive the gifts from my hands; because of this I saw your face as one might see the face of God, and you will be well pleased with me.

11 Take my blessings, which I brought you, because God had mercy on me and I have all things. And he pressed him, and he took them.

12 And he said: Having set out, we shall journey straight ahead.

13 But he said to him: My lord knows that the children are more tender and the sheep and the cattle are giving birth under my care; if therefore I drive them hard for one day, all the livestock will die.

14 Let my lord go ahead before his servant, and I will strengthen myself on the way according to the slow pace of the journey before me and according to the foot of the children, until I come to my lord at Seir.

15 And Esau said: I will leave with you some of the people who are with me. But he said: Why this? It is enough that I found grace before you, lord.

16 And Esau returned that day on his way to Seir.

17 And Jacob departed for Tents; and he made houses for himself there, and for his livestock he made tents. Because of this he called the name of that place Tents.

18 And Jacob came to Salem, a city of Sikima, which is in the land of Chanaan, when he came from Mesopotamia of Syria, and he encamped facing the city.

19 And he acquired the portion of the field where he set his tent there from Emmor, the father of Sychem, for a hundred lambs.

20 And he set up an altar there and called upon the God of Israel.

Chapter 34

1 And Dina, the daughter of Leia, whom she bore to Jacob, went out to observe closely the daughters of the inhabitants.

2 And Sychem the son of Emmor, the Chorrite, the ruler of the land, saw her, and taking her, he slept with her and humbled her.

3 And he attended to the soul of Dina the daughter of Jacob, and he loved the maiden and spoke to her according to the mind of the maiden.

4 And Sychem spoke to Emmor his father, saying: Take this young woman for me as a wife.

5 And Jacob heard that the son of Emmor had defiled Dina his daughter; but his sons were with his livestock in the plain, and Jacob kept silent until they came.

6 And Emmor the father of Sychem went out to Jacob to speak to him.

7 And the sons of Jacob came from the plain; and when they heard, the men were pierced, and it was exceedingly grievous to them, because he had done a shameful thing in Israel by sleeping with the daughter of Jacob; and it shall not be so.

8 And Emmor spoke to them, saying: Sychem my son chose your daughter in his soul; therefore give her to him as a wife.

9 Intermarry with us; give your daughters to us, and take our daughters for your sons.

10 And dwell among us, and behold, the land is broad before you; dwell and trade upon it and acquire possessions in it.

11 And Sychem said to her father and to her brothers: May I find grace before you, and whatever you say, we will give.

12 Increase the dowry greatly, and I will give it, whatever you tell me, and you shall give this girl to me as a wife.

13 But the sons of Jacob answered Sychem and Emmor his father with guile and spoke to them, because they had defiled Dina their sister.

14 And Symeon and Levi, the brothers of Dina and sons of Leia, said to them: We shall not be able to do this thing, to give our sister to a man who has a foreskin; for it is a reproach to us.

15 In this we shall be made like you and dwell among you, if you also become as we are, by having every male of yours circumcised.

16 And we will give our daughters to you, and from your daughters we will take wives for ourselves, and we will dwell beside you and be as one race.

17 But if you do not listen to us, to be circumcised, we will take our daughters and go away.

18 And the words were pleasing before Emmor and before Sychem the son of Emmor.

19 And the young man did not delay to do this thing, for he was devoted to the daughter of Jacob; and he was the most honored of all those in the house of his father.

20 And Emmor and Sychem his son came to the gate of their city and spoke to the men of their city, saying:

21 These men are peaceful with us; let them dwell upon the land and trade upon it, and behold, the land is broad before them. We will take their daughters as wives for ourselves, and we will give our daughters to them.

22 Only in this will the men be made like us, so as to dwell with us and be one people: in every male of ours being circumcised, just as they themselves are circumcised.

23 And will not their livestock and their possessions and their quadrupeds be ours? Only in this let us be made like them, and they will dwell with us.

24 And all who went out through the gate of their city listened to Emmor and Sychem his son, and every male circumcised the flesh of his foreskin.

25 And it happened on the third day, when they were in pain, that the two sons of Jacob, Symeon and Levi, the brothers of Dina, each took his sword and entered the city securely and killed every male.

26 And they killed both Emmor and Sychem his son by the edge of the sword, and they took Dina from the house of Sychem and went out.

27 And the sons of Jacob went in upon the wounded and plundered the city in which they had defiled Dina their sister.

28 And they took their sheep and their cattle and their donkeys, both whatever was in the city and whatever was in the plain.

29 And they took captive all their bodies and all their baggage and their women, and they plundered both whatever was in the city and whatever was in the houses.

30 And Jacob said to Symeon and Levi: You have made me hated, so that I am evil to all those who inhabit the land, among both the Chanaanites and the Pherezites; but I am few in number, and when they gather against me, they will cut me down, and I shall be wiped out, I and my house.

31 But they said: Shall they use our sister as a prostitute?

Chapter 35

1 And God said to Jacob: Arise, go up to the place Baethel and dwell there, and make an altar there to the God who appeared to you when you were running away from the face of Esau your brother.

2 And Jacob said to his house and to all those with him: Remove the foreign gods that are with you from your midst, and cleanse yourselves and change your robes.

3 And arising, let us go up to Baethel and make an altar there to the God who listened to me in the day of affliction, who was with me and brought me safely through the way in which I journeyed.

4 And they gave Jacob the foreign gods that were in their hands and the earrings that were in their ears, and Jacob hid them under the terebinth in Sikima and destroyed them until this day.

5 And Israel departed from Sikima, and the fear of God came upon the cities around them, and they did not pursue after the sons of Israel.

6 And Jacob came to Louza, which is in the land of Chanaan, which is Baethel, he and all the people who were with him.

7 And he built an altar there and called the name of the place Baethel; for there God appeared to him when he was running away from the face of Esau his brother.

8 And Debbora, the nurse of Rebekka, died below Baethel under the oak, and Jacob called its name Oak of Mourning.

9 And God appeared to Jacob while he was still in Louza, when he arrived from Mesopotamia of Syria, and God blessed him.

10 And God said to him: Your name is Jacob; your name shall no longer be called Jacob, but Israel shall be your name.

11 And God said to him: I am your God; increase and multiply; nations and congregations of nations will be from you, and kings will come out from your loin.

12 And the land that I have given to Abraham and Isaac, I have given it to you; it shall be yours, and to your seed after you I will give this land.

13 And God went up from him, out of the place where he spoke with him.

14 And Jacob set up a pillar in the place where he spoke with him, a stone pillar, and he poured a libation upon it and poured oil upon it.

15 And Jacob called the name of the place in which God spoke with him there Baethel.

16 And Jacob departed from Baethel and pitched his tent beyond the tower of Gader. And it happened when he drew near Chabratha, to come into the land Ephratha, that Rachel gave birth and had a difficult labor in the birth.

17 And it happened while she was giving birth with difficulty that the midwife said to her: Take courage, for this one also is a son for you.

18 And it happened as she let go her soul—for she was dying—that she called his name Son of My Pain; but his father called him Benjamin.

19 And Rachel died and was buried on the road to Ephratha [this is Bethlehem].

20 And Jacob set up a pillar upon her memorial; this is the pillar of Rachel’s memorial until this day.

22 And it happened when Israel dwelt in that land that Reuben went and slept with Balla, his father’s concubine; and Israel heard, and it appeared evil before him. And the sons of Jacob were twelve.

23 The sons of Leia: Reuben, Jacob’s firstborn, Symeon, Levi, Judas, Issachar, Zabulon.

24 And the sons of Rachel: Joseph and Benjamin.

25 And the sons of Balla, the female servant of Rachel: Dan and Nephthali.

26 And the sons of Zelpha, the female servant of Leia: Gad and Aser. These are the sons of Jacob who were born to him in Mesopotamia of Syria.

27 And Jacob came to Isaac his father at Mambre, to the city of the plain [this is Chebron], in the land of Chanaan, where Abraham and Isaac sojourned.

28 And the days of Isaac that he lived were a hundred eighty years.

29 And expiring, he died and was added to his race, older and full of days; and Esau and Jacob his sons buried him.

Chapter 36

1 And these are the generations of Esau [he is Edom].

2 And Esau took women for himself from the daughters of the Chanaanites: Ada the daughter of Ailon the Chettite, and Elibema the daughter of Ana the son of Sebegon the Evite,

3 and Basemmath the daughter of Ismael, the sister of Nabaioth.

4 And Ada bore Eliphas to Esau, and Basemmath bore Raguel,

5 and Elibema bore Jeous and Jeglom and Kore. These are the sons of Esau who were born to him in the land of Chanaan.

6 And Esau took his women and his sons and his daughters and all the bodies of his house and all his possessions and all his livestock and everything that he acquired and everything that he procured in the land of Chanaan, and he journeyed from the land of Chanaan, away from the face of Jacob his brother.

7 For their possessions were too many for them to dwell together, and the land of their sojourning was not able to bear them because of the multitude of their possessions.

8 And Esau dwelt on Mount Seir [Esau himself is Edom].

9 And these are the generations of Esau, the father of Edom, on Mount Seir,

10 and these are the names of the sons of Esau: Eliphas the son of Ada, the woman of Esau, and Raguel the son of Basemmath, the woman of Esau.

11 And the sons of Eliphas were: Thaiman, Omar, Sophar, Gothom, and Kenez.

12 And Thamna was a concubine of Eliphas the son of Esau, and she bore Amalek to Eliphas. These are the sons of Ada, the woman of Esau.

13 And these are the sons of Raguel: Nachoth, Zare, Some, and Moze. These were the sons of Basemmath, the woman of Esau.

14 And these were the sons of Elibema, the daughter of Ana the son of Sebegon, the woman of Esau; and she bore Jeous and Jeglom and Kore to Esau. –

15 These are the rulers, the sons of Esau. The sons of Eliphas, the firstborn of Esau: ruler Thaiman, ruler Omar, ruler Sophar, ruler Kenez,

16 ruler Kore, ruler Gothom, ruler Amalek. These are the rulers of Eliphas in the land of Idoumea; these are the sons of Ada.

17 And these are the sons of Raguel, the son of Esau: ruler Nachoth, ruler Zare, ruler Some, ruler Moze. These are the rulers of Raguel in the land of Edom; these are the sons of Basemmath, the woman of Esau.

18 And these are the sons of Elibema, the woman of Esau: ruler Jeous, ruler Jeglom, ruler Kore. These are the rulers of Elibema. –

19 These are the sons of Esau, and these are their rulers. These are the sons of Edom.

20 And these are the sons of Seir the Chorrite who inhabits the land: Lotan, Sobal, Sebegon, Ana,

21 and Deson and Asar and Rison. These are the rulers of the Chorrite, the son of Seir, in the land of Edom.

22 And the sons of Lotan were: Chorri and Aiman; and the sister of Lotan was Thamna.

23 And these are the sons of Sobal: Golon and Manachath and Gaibel, Soph and Oman.

24 And these are the sons of Sebegon: Aie and Onan. This is Onas, who found Jamin in the wilderness when he was tending the draft animals of Sebegon his father.

25 And these are the sons of Ana: Deson; and Elibema was a daughter of Ana.

26 And these are the sons of Deson: Amada and Asban and Jethran and Charran.

27 And these are the sons of Asar: Balaan and Zoukam and Jooukam and Oukan.

28 And these are the sons of Rison: Os and Aram. –

29 These are the rulers of Chorri: ruler Lotan, ruler Sobal, ruler Sebegon, ruler Ana,

30 ruler Deson, ruler Asar, ruler Rison. These are the rulers of Chorri in their rulerships in the land of Edom.

31 And these are the kings who reigned in Edom before a king reigned in Israel.

32 And Balak the son of Beor reigned in Edom, and the name of his city was Dennaba.

33 And Balak died, and Jobab the son of Zara from Bosorra reigned instead of him.

34 And Jobab died, and Asom from the land of the Thaimanites reigned instead of him.

35 And Asom died, and Adad the son of Barad, who cut down Madiam in the plain of Moab, reigned instead of him, and the name of his city was Geththaim.

36 And Adad died, and Samala from Masekka reigned instead of him.

37 And Samala died, and Saul from Rooboth by the river reigned instead of him.

38 And Saul died, and Balaennon the son of Achobor reigned instead of him.

39 And Balaennon the son of Achobor died, and Arad the son of Barad reigned instead of him, and the name of his city was Phogor; and the name of his woman was Maitabeel, the daughter of Matraith the son of Maizoob.

40 These are the names of the rulers of Esau in their tribes, according to their place, in their territories and in their nations: ruler Thamna, ruler Gola, ruler Jether,

41 ruler Elibemas, ruler Elas, ruler Phinon,

42 ruler Kenez, ruler Thaiman, ruler Mazar,

43 ruler Megediel, ruler Zaphoim. These are the rulers of Edom in the inhabited places in the land of their possession. This is Esau, the father of Edom.

Chapter 37

1 And Jacob dwelt in the land where his father sojourned, in the land of Chanaan.

2 And these are the generations of Jacob. Joseph was seventeen years old, shepherding the sheep with his brothers while young, with the sons of Balla and with the sons of Zelpha, the women of his father; and Joseph brought an evil reproach to Israel their father.

3 And Jacob loved Joseph beyond all his sons, because he was a son of old age to him; and he made him a multicolored tunic.

4 And when his brothers saw that their father loved him from among all his sons, they hated him and were not able to speak anything peaceful to him.

5 And Joseph dreamed a dream and reported it to his brothers,

6 and he said to them: Hear this dream that I dreamed.

7 I thought we were binding bundles in the midst of the plain, and my bundle arose and stood upright, and your bundles turned around and bowed down to my bundle.

8 And his brothers said to him: Reigning, will you reign over us, or ruling, will you rule us? And they added still more to their hatred of him because of his dreams and because of his words. –

9 And he saw another dream and related it to his father and to his brothers and said: Behold, I dreamed another dream, as though the sun and the moon and eleven stars were bowing down to me.

10 And his father rebuked him and said to him: What is this dream that you dreamed? Having come, shall we indeed come—I and your mother and your brothers—to bow down to you upon the ground?

11 And his brothers envied him, but his father preserved the word.

12 And his brothers journeyed to shepherd the sheep of their father in Sychem.

13 And Israel said to Joseph: Are not your brothers shepherding in Sychem? Come, I will send you to them. And he said to him: Behold, I am here.

14 And Israel said to him: Go and see whether your brothers and the sheep are healthy, and report to me. And he sent him from the valley of Chebron, and he came to Sychem.

15 And a man found him wandering in the plain; and the man questioned him, saying: What are you seeking?

16 And he said: I am seeking my brothers; report to me where they are shepherding.

17 And the man said to him: They have departed from here, for I heard them saying: Let us journey to Dothaim. And Joseph journeyed after his brothers and found them in Dothaim.

18 And they foresaw him from far away, before he drew near to them, and they plotted evil to kill him.

19 And each said to his brother: Behold, that dreamer is coming.

20 Now therefore, come, let us kill him and throw him into one of the pits, and we will say: An evil beast devoured him. And we will see what his dreams will be.

21 But Reuben heard and rescued him from their hands and said: We shall not strike him to death.

22 And Reuben said to them: Do not shed blood; cast him into this pit in the wilderness, but do not bring a hand upon him—so that he might rescue him from their hands and restore him to his father.

23 And it happened when Joseph came to his brothers that they stripped Joseph of the multicolored tunic that was around him,

24 and taking him, they threw him into the pit; and the pit was empty and had no water.

25 And they sat down to eat bread, and looking up with their eyes, they saw, and behold, Ismaelite travelers were coming from Galaad, and their camels were loaded with incense and resin and stacte; and they were journeying to bring them down into Egypt.

26 And Judas said to his brothers: What use is it if we kill our brother and hide his blood?

27 Come, let us sell him to these Ismaelites, but let our hands not be upon him, because he is our brother and our flesh. And his brothers listened.

28 And the Madianite men, the merchants, were passing by, and they pulled and brought Joseph up out of the pit and sold Joseph to the Ismaelites for twenty gold pieces, and they brought Joseph down into Egypt.

29 And Reuben returned to the pit and did not see Joseph in the pit, and he tore his garments.

30 And he returned to his brothers and said: The boy is not here; and I, where am I to go now?

31 And taking the tunic of Joseph, they slaughtered a kid of the goats and stained the tunic with the blood.

32 And they sent the multicolored tunic and brought it to their father and said: We found this; recognize whether it is the tunic of your son or not.

33 And he recognized it and said: It is the tunic of my son; an evil beast devoured him, a beast seized Joseph.

34 And Jacob tore his garments and put sackcloth upon his loin and mourned his son for many days.

35 And all his sons and daughters gathered and came to comfort him, and he did not wish to be comforted, saying: I shall go down to my son mourning, into Hades. And his father wept for him. –

36 And the Madianites sold Joseph in Egypt to Petephres, the eunuch of Pharao, the chief cook.

Chapter 38

1 And it happened at that time that Judas went down from his brothers and arrived as far as a certain Odollamite man whose name was Iras.

2 And Judas saw there the daughter of a Chanaanite man whose name was Saua, and he took her and went in to her.

3 And conceiving, she bore a son and called his name Er.

4 And conceiving again, she bore a son and called his name Aunan.

5 And adding again, she bore a son and called his name Selom. And she was in Chasbi when she bore them.

6 And Judas took a woman for Er his firstborn, whose name was Thamar.

7 And Er, the firstborn of Judas, became evil before the Lord, and God killed him.

8 And Judas said to Aunan: Go in to the woman of your brother, and perform the duty of a brother-in-law with her, and raise up seed for your brother.

9 But Aunan, knowing that the seed would not be his, would, whenever he went in to the woman of his brother, pour it out upon the ground so as not to give seed to his brother.

10 And it appeared evil before God that he did this, and he put this one to death also.

11 And Judas said to Thamar his daughter-in-law: Sit as a widow in the house of your father until Selom my son becomes grown. For he said: Lest this one also die like his brothers. And Thamar went away and sat in the house of her father.

12 And the days were multiplied, and Saua the woman of Judas died; and being comforted, Judas went up to those shearing his sheep, he and Iras his shepherd, the Odollamite, to Thamna.

13 And it was reported to Thamar his daughter-in-law, saying: Behold, your father-in-law is going up to Thamna to shear his sheep.

14 And removing the garments of her widowhood from herself, she put on a veil and beautified herself and sat by the gates of Ainan, which is on the way to Thamna; for she saw that Selom had become grown, but he had not given her to him as a woman.

15 And Judas saw her and thought her to be a prostitute, for she had covered her face, and he did not recognize her.

16 And he turned aside from the road toward her and said to her: Allow me to go in to you; for he did not know that she was his daughter-in-law. And she said: What will you give me if you go in to me?

17 And he said: I will send you a kid of the goats from the sheep. And she said: If you give a pledge until you send it.

18 And he said: What pledge shall I give you? And she said: Your ring and necklace and the staff that is in your hand. And he gave them to her and went in to her, and she conceived by him.

19 And arising, she went away and removed the veil from herself and put on the garments of her widowhood.

20 And Judas sent the kid from the goats by the hand of his shepherd, the Odollamite, to recover the pledge from the woman, and he did not find her.

21 And he questioned the men from the place: Where is the prostitute who was in Ainan by the road? And they said: There was no prostitute here.

22 And he returned to Judas and said: I did not find her, and the men from the place say that there is no prostitute here.

23 And Judas said: Let her have them, but let us not perhaps be laughed at; I sent this kid, but you did not find her.

24 And it happened after three months that it was reported to Judas, saying: Thamar your daughter-in-law has prostituted herself, and behold, she is pregnant from prostitution. And Judas said: Bring her out, and let her be burned.

25 And as she was being led away, she sent to her father-in-law, saying: By the man whose these things are, I am pregnant. And she said: Recognize whose ring and necklace and staff these are.

26 And Judas recognized them and said: Thamar has been justified rather than I, because I did not give her to Selom my son. And he did not add again to know her.

27 And it happened when she was giving birth, and there were twins in her womb.

28 And it happened while she was giving birth that one put his hand out first; and the midwife took it and bound scarlet upon his hand, saying: This one will come out first.

29 But when he drew his hand back, immediately his brother came out. And she said: Why was a barrier cut through because of you? And she called his name Phares.

30 And after this his brother came out, upon whose hand was the scarlet; and she called his name Zara.

Chapter 39

1 And Joseph was brought down into Egypt, and Petephres, the eunuch of Pharao, the chief cook, an Egyptian man, acquired him from the hand of the Ismaelites who brought him down there.

2 And the Lord was with Joseph, and he was a man succeeding, and he came to be in the house beside his Egyptian lord.

3 And his lord knew that the Lord was with him, and whatever he did, the Lord prospered it in his hands.

4 And Joseph found grace before his lord and was pleasing to him, and he appointed him over his house, and everything that was his he gave through the hand of Joseph.

5 And it happened after he was appointed over his house and over everything that was his that the Lord blessed the house of the Egyptian because of Joseph, and the blessing of the Lord came to be in all his possessions in the house and in the field.

6 And he entrusted everything that was his into the hands of Joseph, and he knew nothing of his own affairs except the bread that he himself ate. And Joseph was handsome in form and exceedingly beautiful in appearance.

7 And it happened after these words that the woman of his lord cast her eyes upon Joseph and said: Sleep with me.

8 But he did not wish to, and he said to the woman of his lord: If my lord knows nothing in his house because of me and has given everything that is his into my hands,

9 and nothing in this house is above me, nor has anything been withheld from me except you, because you are his woman, then how shall I do this evil thing and sin before God?

10 And when she spoke to Joseph day after day, he did not listen to her, to sleep with her, to be with her. –

11 And it happened on a certain such day that Joseph entered the house to do his works, and no one of those in the house was inside,

12 and she dragged him by his garments, saying: Sleep with me. And leaving his garments in her hands, he fled and went out outside.

13 And it happened when she saw that he had left his garments in her hands and fled and went out outside,

14 that she called those who were in the house and spoke to them, saying: See, he brought a Hebrew servant in to us to mock us; he came in to me, saying: Sleep with me, and I cried out with a great voice.

15 And when he heard that I raised my voice and cried out, he left his garments beside me and fled and went out outside.

16 And she leaves the garments beside herself until the lord came to his house.

17 And she spoke to him according to these words, saying: The Hebrew servant whom you brought in to us came in to me to mock me and said to me: I shall sleep with you.

18 But when he heard that I raised my voice and cried out, he left his garments beside me and fled and went out outside.

19 And it happened when his lord heard the words of his woman, as many as she spoke to him, saying: Thus your servant did to me, that he became angry with wrath.

20 And the lord of Joseph took him and cast him into the fortress, into the place in which the prisoners of the king are held there in the fortress.

21 And the Lord was with Joseph and poured mercy over him and gave him grace before the chief jailer.

22 And the chief jailer gave the prison through the hand of Joseph, and all those who had been led away, as many as were in the prison, and everything that they do there.

23 The chief jailer of the prison knew nothing because of him, for everything was through the hand of Joseph, because the Lord was with him; and whatever he did, the Lord prospered it in his hands.

Chapter 40

1 And it happened after these words that the chief wine-pourer of the king of Egypt and the chief baker sinned against their lord, the king of Egypt.

2 And Pharao was angry with his two eunuchs, with the chief wine-pourer and with the chief baker,

3 and he placed them in custody beside the jailer, in the prison, in the place where Joseph had been led away, there.

4 And the chief jailer entrusted them to Joseph, and he attended them; and they were days in custody. –

5 And both saw a dream, each his dream, in one night, the vision of his dream—the chief wine-pourer and the chief baker, who belonged to the king of Egypt, who were in the prison.

6 And Joseph came in to them in the morning and saw them, and they were troubled.

7 And he questioned the eunuchs of Pharao who were with him in custody beside his lord, saying: Why are your faces gloomy today?

8 And they said to him: We saw a dream, and there is no one interpreting it. And Joseph said to them: Is not their explanation through God? Therefore relate them to me. –

9 And the chief wine-pourer related his dream to Joseph and said: In my sleep a vine was before me,

10 and in the vine were three stems, and it was blooming, having produced shoots; the clusters of grapes were ripe.

11 And the cup of Pharao was in my hand, and I took the cluster of grapes and squeezed it into the cup and gave the cup into the hands of Pharao.

12 And Joseph said to him: This is its interpretation: the three stems are three days.

13 Yet three days, and Pharao will remember your office and restore you to your office of chief wine-pourer, and you will give the cup of Pharao into his hand according to your former office, as you were pouring wine.

14 But remember me through yourself when it becomes well for you, and you will do mercy with me and remind Pharao about me and bring me out of this fortress.

15 For by theft I was stolen from the land of the Hebrews, and here I did nothing, but they cast me into this pit. –

16 And the chief baker saw that he had interpreted rightly and said to Joseph: I also saw a dream, and I thought I was carrying three baskets of coarse loaves upon my head,

17 and in the upper basket were some of all the kinds that King Pharao eats, the work of a baker, and the birds of heaven were devouring them from the basket above my head.

18 And Joseph answered and said to him: This is its interpretation: the three baskets are three days.

19 Yet three days, and Pharao will remove your head from you and hang you upon wood, and the birds of heaven will eat your flesh from you. –

20 And it happened on the third day—it was the birthday of Pharao—and he made a drinking feast for all his servants. And he remembered the office of the chief wine-pourer and the office of the chief baker in the midst of his servants,

21 and he restored the chief wine-pourer to his office, and he gave the cup into the hand of Pharao,

22 but he hanged the chief baker, just as Joseph had interpreted to them.

23 But the chief wine-pourer did not remember Joseph, but forgot him.

Chapter 41

1 And it happened after two years of days that Pharao saw a dream. He thought he was standing upon the river,

2 and behold, as though from the river seven cows were coming up, beautiful in appearance and choice in flesh, and were grazing in the marsh grass.

3 And seven other cows were coming up after these from the river, ugly in appearance and thin in flesh, and were grazing beside the cows by the lip of the river.

4 And the seven cows that were ugly and thin in flesh devoured the seven cows that were beautiful in appearance and choice. And Pharao awoke. –

5 And he dreamed a second time, and behold, seven ears of grain were coming up on one stalk, choice and beautiful.

6 And seven other ears, thin and wind-blasted, were sprouting after them.

7 And the seven thin and wind-blasted ears swallowed the seven choice and full ears. And Pharao awoke, and it was a dream.

8 And morning came, and his soul was troubled; and sending, he called all the interpreters of Egypt and all its wise men, and Pharao related the dream to them, and there was no one who could report it to Pharao.

9 And the chief wine-pourer spoke to Pharao, saying: I call my sin to remembrance today.

10 Pharao was angry with his servants and placed us in custody in the house of the chief cook, both me and the chief baker.

11 And we saw a dream in one night, both I and he; we each saw according to his own dream.

12 And a young man was there with us, a Hebrew servant of the chief cook, and we related them to him, and he interpreted them for us.

13 And it happened just as he interpreted them for us; thus it also came to pass: I was restored to my office, but that one was hanged.

14 And Pharao sent and called Joseph, and they brought him out of the fortress and shaved him and changed his robe, and he came to Pharao.

15 And Pharao said to Joseph: I have seen a dream, and there is no one interpreting it; but I have heard people saying about you that when you hear dreams, you interpret them.

16 And Joseph answered Pharao and said: Without God, the salvation of Pharao will not be answered.

17 And Pharao spoke to Joseph, saying: In my sleep I thought I was standing beside the lip of the river,

18 and as though from the river seven cows were coming up, beautiful in appearance and choice in flesh, and were grazing in the marsh grass.

19 And behold, seven other cows were coming up behind them from the river, evil and ugly in appearance and thin in flesh, such as I did not see uglier than these in the whole land of Egypt.

20 And the seven ugly and thin cows devoured the first seven beautiful and choice cows,

21 and they entered their bellies, and it did not become evident that they had entered their bellies, and their appearances were ugly just as at the beginning. And having awakened, I slept,

22 and again I saw in my sleep, and as though seven ears of grain were coming up on one stalk, full and beautiful.

23 And seven other ears, thin and wind-blasted, were sprouting next to them.

24 And the seven thin and wind-blasted ears swallowed the seven beautiful and full ears. Therefore I spoke to the interpreters, and there was no one who could report it to me.

25 And Joseph said to Pharao: The dream of Pharao is one. As many things as God is doing, he has shown to Pharao.

26 The seven beautiful cows are seven years, and the seven beautiful ears are seven years; the dream of Pharao is one.

27 And the seven thin cows coming up behind them are seven years, and the seven thin and wind-blasted ears will be seven years of famine.

28 And as for the word that I have said to Pharao: As many things as God is doing, he has shown to Pharao.

29 Behold, seven years are coming, a great abundance in all the land of Egypt.

30 But seven years of famine will come after these, and they will forget the fullness in the whole land of Egypt, and the famine will consume the land.

31 And the abundance will not be recognized upon the land because of the famine that will be after these, for it will be exceedingly severe.

32 And concerning the dream of Pharao being repeated twice: it is because the word from God will be true, and God will hasten to do it.

33 Now therefore, look for a prudent and intelligent man and appoint him over the land of Egypt.

34 And let Pharao act and appoint district rulers over the land, and let them take a fifth of all the produce of the land of Egypt during the seven years of abundance.

35 And let them gather all the foods of these seven coming good years, and let the grain be gathered under the hand of Pharao; let foods be guarded in the cities.

36 And the foods will be kept for the land for the seven years of famine that will be in the land of Egypt, and the land will not be destroyed in the famine.

37 And the words were pleasing before Pharao and before all his servants.

38 And Pharao said to all his servants: Shall we find such a man, who has the spirit of God in him?

39 And Pharao said to Joseph: Since God has shown you all these things, there is no man more prudent and intelligent than you.

40 You will be over my house, and all my people will obey at your mouth; only in the throne will I be above you.

41 And Pharao said to Joseph: Behold, today I appoint you over all the land of Egypt.

42 And Pharao removed the ring from his hand and put it upon the hand of Joseph, and clothed him in a linen robe and put a golden collar around his neck.

43 And he mounted him upon his second chariot, and a herald proclaimed before him; and he appointed him over the whole land of Egypt.

44 And Pharao said to Joseph: I am Pharao; without you no one will lift his hand in all the land of Egypt.

45 And Pharao called the name of Joseph Psonthomphanech; and he gave him Asenneth, the daughter of Petephre, priest of the City of the Sun, as a woman for him.

46 And Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharao, king of Egypt. And Joseph went out from the face of Pharao and passed through all the land of Egypt.

47 And in the seven years of abundance the land produced bundles.

48 And he gathered all the foods of the seven years in which there was abundance in the land of Egypt and placed the foods in the cities; the foods of the fields around each city he placed in it.

49 And Joseph gathered grain like the sand of the sea, exceedingly much, until they were not able to count it, for there was no number.

50 And two sons were born to Joseph before the seven years of famine came, whom Asenneth the daughter of Petephre, priest of the City of the Sun, bore to him.

51 And Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasse, because: God made me forget all my pains and all the things of my father.

52 And he called the name of the second Ephraim, because: God increased me in the land of my humiliation.

53 And the seven years of abundance that came to be in the land of Egypt passed.

54 And the seven years of famine began to come, just as Joseph said. And famine came to be in all the land, but in all the land of Egypt there were breads.

55 And all the land of Egypt hungered, and the people cried to Pharao concerning breads; and Pharao said to all the Egyptians: Go to Joseph, and whatever he tells you, do.

56 And the famine was upon the face of all the land; and Joseph opened all the granaries and sold to all the Egyptians.

57 And all the regions came into Egypt to buy from Joseph, for the famine prevailed in all the land.

Chapter 42

1 And Jacob saw that there was a sale in Egypt and said to his sons: Why are you idle?

2 Behold, I have heard that there is grain in Egypt; go down there and buy us a little food, so that we may live and not die.

3 And the ten brothers of Joseph went down to buy grain from Egypt.

4 But Benjamin, the brother of Joseph, he did not send with his brothers, for he said: Lest some weakness happen to him.

5 And the sons of Israel came to buy with those who were coming, for the famine was in the land of Chanaan.

6 And Joseph was ruler of the land; he was the one selling to all the people of the land. And the brothers of Joseph came and bowed down to him upon their faces upon the ground.

7 And Joseph saw his brothers and recognized them, and he estranged himself from them and spoke harsh things to them and said to them: From where have you come? And they said: From the land of Chanaan, to buy food.

8 And Joseph recognized his brothers, but they did not recognize him.

9 And Joseph remembered the dreams that he himself had seen and said to them: You are spies; you have come to examine the tracks of the country.

10 And they said: No, lord; your servants came to buy food.

11 We are all sons of one man; we are peaceful; your servants are not spies.

12 And he said to them: No, but you came to see the tracks of the land.

13 And they said: We, your servants, are twelve brothers in the land of Chanaan, and behold, the youngest is with our father today, but the other does not exist.

14 And Joseph said to them: This is what I have said to you, saying that you are spies.

15 By this you will be made manifest: by the health of Pharao, you shall certainly not leave from here unless your youngest brother comes here.

16 Send one from among you and take your brother, but you are to be led away until your words become manifest, whether you speak truth or not; but if not, by the health of Pharao, surely you are spies.

17 And he placed them in custody for three days.

18 And he said to them on the third day: Do this and you will live—for I fear God—

19 if you are peaceful, let one of your brothers be held in custody, but you yourselves walk and carry away the purchase of your grain-ration,

20 and bring your youngest brother to me, and your words will be believed; but if not, you will die. And they did so. –

21 And each said to his brother: Yes, for we are in sin concerning our brother, because we overlooked the affliction of his soul when he pleaded with us, and we did not listen to him; on account of this, this affliction has come upon us.

22 And Reuben answered and said to them: Did I not speak to you, saying: Do not wrong the boy? And you did not listen to me; and behold, his blood is sought.

23 But they did not know that Joseph was hearing, for the interpreter was between them.

24 And Joseph turned away from them and wept. – And again he came to them and spoke to them, and he took Symeon from them and bound him before them.

25 And Joseph commanded that their vessels be filled with grain and that each one’s silver be returned into his sack and that provisions be given to them for the way. And thus it came to be for them.

26 And placing the grain upon their donkeys, they went away from there. –

27 And one loosened his purse to give fodder to his donkeys where they lodged, and he saw the bundle of his silver, and it was on top of the mouth of the purse.

28 And he said to his brothers: My silver was returned to me, and behold, this is in my purse. And their heart was astonished, and they were troubled with one another, saying: What is this that God has done to us?

29 And they came to Jacob their father in the land of Chanaan and reported to him everything that had happened to them, saying:

30 The man, the lord of the land, has spoken harsh things to us and placed us in custody as men spying out the land.

31 And we said to him: We are peaceful; we are not spies.

32 We are twelve brothers, sons of our father; the one does not exist, but the youngest is with our father today in the land of Chanaan.

33 And the man, the lord of the land, said to us: By this I will know that you are peaceful: leave one brother here with me, but take the purchase of the grain-ration of your house and go away,

34 and bring your youngest brother to me, and I will know that you are not spies but are peaceful, and I will restore your brother to you, and trade in the land.

35 And it happened while they were emptying their sacks that the bundle of each one’s silver was in their sack; and they and their father saw the bundles of their silver and were afraid.

36 And Jacob their father said to them: You have made me childless; Joseph does not exist, Symeon does not exist, and you will take Benjamin. All these things have come upon me.

37 And Reuben spoke to his father, saying: Kill my two sons if I do not bring him to you; give him into my hand, and I will bring him back to you.

38 But he said: My son shall not go down with you, because his brother died and he alone has been left; and it will happen that he is afflicted by weakness on the way in which you journey, and you will bring my old age down with sorrow into Hades.

Chapter 43

1 And the famine grew strong upon the land.

2 And it happened when they finished eating the grain that they had brought from Egypt that their father said to them: Go again and buy us a little food.

3 And Judas spoke to him, saying: With a testimony the man testified to us, saying: You shall not see my face unless your youngest brother is with you.

4 If therefore you send our brother with us, we will go down and buy food for you.

5 But if you do not send our brother with us, we will not journey, for the man said to us: You shall not see my face unless your youngest brother is with you.

6 And Israel said: Why did you harm me by reporting to the man whether you had a brother?

7 And they said: Questioning, the man questioned us and our family, saying: Is your father still living? Do you have a brother? And we reported to him according to this questioning. Surely we did not know that he would say to us: Bring your brother.

8 And Judas said to Israel his father: Send the boy with me, and arising, we shall journey, so that we may live and not die, both we and you and our baggage.

9 And I receive responsibility for him; seek him from my hand. If I do not bring him to you and stand him before you, I will have sinned against you all the days.

10 For if we had not delayed, we would already have returned twice.

11 And Israel their father said to them: If it is so, do this: take some of the fruits of the land in your vessels and bring gifts down to the man—some resin and honey, incense and stacte and terebinth and nuts.

12 And take double silver in your hands; return with you the silver that was returned in your purses, lest perhaps it was a mistake.

13 And take your brother, and arise and go down to the man.

14 And may my God give you grace before the man and send away your one brother and Benjamin; but as for me, just as I have been made childless, I have been made childless.

15 And the men took these gifts and took the double silver in their hands and Benjamin, and arising, they went down into Egypt and stood before Joseph.

16 And Joseph saw them and Benjamin his brother from the same mother and said to the one over his house: Bring the men into the house, and slaughter sacrifices and prepare, for the men will eat breads with me at midday.

17 And the man did just as Joseph said and brought the men into the house of Joseph. –

18 And when the men saw that they had been brought into the house of Joseph, they said: Because of the silver that was returned in our purses at the beginning, we are being brought in, to accuse us falsely and attack us, to take us as servants, and our donkeys.

19 And approaching the man who was over the house of Joseph, they spoke to him in the gateway of the house,

20 saying: We beseech you, lord; we came down at the beginning to buy food.

21 And it happened when we came to lodge and opened our purses that here was the silver of each one in his purse; and our silver by weight we have now returned in our hands.

22 And we brought other silver with ourselves to buy food; we do not know who put the silver into our purses.

23 And he said to them: Mercy be to you; do not fear. Your God and the God of your fathers gave you treasures in your purses, but I have received your silver as approved payment. And he brought Symeon out to them,

24 and he brought water to wash their feet and gave fodder to their donkeys.

25 And they prepared the gifts until Joseph came at midday, for they heard that he was going to eat lunch there.

26 And Joseph entered the house, and they brought him the gifts that they had in their hands into the house and bowed down to him upon their faces upon the ground.

27 And he questioned them: How are you? And he said to them: Is your elderly father, whom you mentioned, healthy? Is he still living?

28 And they said: Your servant our father is healthy; he is still living. And he said: Blessed is that man by God. And bending down, they bowed down to him.

29 And Joseph looked up with his eyes and saw Benjamin his brother from the same mother and said: Is this your youngest brother, whom you said you would bring to me? And he said: May God have mercy on you, child.

30 And Joseph was troubled—for his inward parts were twisting over his brother—and he sought to weep; and entering the private chamber, he wept there.

31 And washing his face, he came out and restrained himself and said: Set out breads.

32 And they set out for him alone, and for them by themselves, and for the Egyptians dining with him by themselves; for the Egyptians were not able to eat breads together with the Hebrews, for it is an abomination to the Egyptians.

33 And they sat before him, the firstborn according to his seniority and the youngest according to his youth; and the men were astonished, each toward his brother.

34 And they lifted portions from him toward themselves; but the portion of Benjamin was made greater than the portions of all, fivefold compared with theirs. And they drank and became drunk with him.

Chapter 44

1 And Joseph commanded the one who was over his house, saying: Fill the purses of the men with as much food as they are able to carry, and put each one’s silver at the mouth of his purse,

2 and put my silver cup into the purse of the youngest, along with the price of his grain. And it happened according to the word of Joseph, just as he said. –

3 The morning dawned, and the men were sent away, they and their donkeys.

4 And when they had gone out of the city [they were not far away], Joseph said to the one over his house: Arise, pursue after the men and overtake them, and say to them: Why is it that you repaid evil in place of good?

5 Why did you steal my silver cup? Is this not that in which my lord drinks? And by divination he practices divination in it. You have brought to completion evil things that you have done.

6 And finding them, he spoke to them according to these words.

7 And they said to him: Why does the lord speak according to these words? May it not happen that your servants do according to this word.

8 If we returned to you from the land of Chanaan the silver that we found in our purses, how could we steal silver or gold from the house of your lord?

9 With whomever among your servants the cup is found, let him die; and we also will be servants to our lord.

10 And he said: Even now, as you say, so it will be; the man with whom the cup is found, he will be my servant, but you will be clean.

11 And they hastened, and each brought his purse down upon the ground, and each opened his purse.

12 And he searched, beginning from the eldest until he came to the youngest, and he found the cup in the purse of Benjamin.

13 And they tore their garments, and each placed his purse upon his donkey, and they returned to the city.

14 And Judas and his brothers entered to Joseph while he was still there, and they fell before him upon the ground.

15 And Joseph said to them: What is this deed that you have done? Do you not know that by divination a man such as I practices divination?

16 And Judas said: What shall we answer our lord, or what shall we speak, or how shall we be justified? But God has found the unrighteousness of your servants. Behold, we are household servants to our lord, both we and he with whom the cup was found.

17 And Joseph said: May it not happen to me to do this thing; the man with whom the cup was found, he will be my servant, but you go up with salvation to your father.

18 And Judas drew near to him and said: I beseech you, lord, let your servant speak a word before you, and do not be angry with your servant, because you are with Pharao.

19 Lord, you questioned your servants, saying: Do you have a father or a brother?

20 And we said to the lord: We have an elderly father and a younger child of old age for him, and his brother died, and he alone was left to his mother, and his father loved him.

21 And you said to your servants: Bring him down to me, and I will care for him.

22 And we said to the lord: The child will not be able to leave his father; but if he leaves his father, he will die.

23 But you said to your servants: Unless your youngest brother comes down with you, you shall not add again to see my face.

24 And it happened when we went up to your servant, namely our father, that we reported the words of the lord to him.

25 And our father said to us: Walk again; buy us a little food.

26 But we said: We will not be able to go down; but if our youngest brother goes down with us, we will go down, for we will not be able to see the face of the man if our youngest brother is not with us.

27 And your servant our father said to us: You know that my woman bore me two.

28 And the one went out from me, and you said that he had become beast-eaten, and I have not seen him still even now.

29 If therefore you take this one also from my face and some weakness happens to him on the way, then you will bring my old age down with sorrow into Hades.

30 Now therefore, if I enter to your servant, namely our father, and the boy is not with us—his soul hangs from this one’s soul—

31 then it will happen when he sees that the boy is not with us that he will die, and your servants will bring the old age of your servant, namely our father, down with pain into Hades.

32 For your servant has received responsibility for the boy from the father, saying: If I do not bring him to you and stand him before you, I will have sinned against the father all the days.

33 Now therefore, I will remain beside you as a servant in place of the boy, a household servant of the lord; but let the boy go up with his brothers.

34 For how shall I go up to the father when the boy is not with us? Let me not see the evils that will find my father.

Chapter 45

1 And Joseph was not able to endure all those standing beside him, but said: Send everyone away from me. And no one was still standing beside Joseph when he made himself known to his brothers.

2 And he let out his voice with weeping; and all the Egyptians heard, and it became audible in the house of Pharao.

3 And Joseph said to his brothers: I am Joseph. Is my father still living? And his brothers were not able to answer him, for they were troubled.

4 And Joseph said to his brothers: Draw near to me. And they drew near. And he said: I am Joseph your brother, whom you sold into Egypt.

5 Now therefore, do not be grieved, nor let it appear hard to you that you sold me here, for God sent me before you for life.

6 For this is the second year that famine is upon the land, and there are still five years remaining in which there will be neither plowing nor harvest.

7 For God sent me before you so that a remnant of you might be left upon the earth and to nourish a great remnant of you.

8 Now therefore, you did not send me here, but rather God; and he made me as a father to Pharao and lord of all his house and ruler of all the land of Egypt.

9 Therefore hasten and go up to my father and say to him: Thus says your son Joseph: God made me lord of all the land of Egypt; therefore come down to me and do not remain.

10 And you will dwell in the land of Gesem of Arabia and will be near me, you and your sons and the sons of your sons, your sheep and your cattle and whatever is yours.

11 And I will nourish you there—for there are still five years of famine—so that you are not wiped out, you and your sons and all your possessions.

12 Behold, your eyes see, and the eyes of Benjamin my brother, that it is my mouth speaking to you.

13 Therefore report to my father all my glory that is in Egypt and everything that you saw, and hasten and bring my father down here.

14 And falling upon the neck of Benjamin his brother, he wept over him, and Benjamin wept upon his neck.

15 And kissing all his brothers, he wept over them; and after these things his brothers spoke to him.

16 And the report was spread into the house of Pharao, saying: The brothers of Joseph have come. And Pharao and his attendants rejoiced.

17 And Pharao said to Joseph: Say to your brothers: Do this: load your conveyances and go away into the land of Chanaan,

18 and take your father and your possessions and come to me, and I will give you some of all the good things of Egypt, and you will eat the marrow of the land.

19 And you, command these things: that they take wagons from the land of Egypt for your children and your women, and take up your father and come.

20 And do not spare your goods with your eyes, for all the good things of Egypt will be yours.

21 And the sons of Israel did so; and Joseph gave them wagons according to the things spoken by Pharao the king and gave them provisions for the way.

22 And he gave double robes to all, but to Benjamin he gave three hundred gold pieces and five changes of robes.

23 And to his father he sent the same, and ten donkeys carrying some of all the good things of Egypt and ten she-mules carrying breads for his father for the way.

24 And he sent his brothers away, and they journeyed; and he said to them: Do not be angry on the way.

25 And they went up from Egypt and came into the land of Chanaan to Jacob their father,

26 and they reported to him, saying: Your son Joseph is living, and he rules all the land of Egypt. And the mind of Jacob was beside itself, for he did not believe them.

27 And they spoke to him all the things spoken by Joseph, as many as he had said to them. And when he saw the wagons that Joseph had sent to take him up, the spirit of Jacob their father was rekindled.

28 And Israel said: It is great to me if Joseph my son is still living; I will journey and see him before I die.

Chapter 46

1 And Israel departed, he and all that was his, and came to the Well of the Oath and sacrificed a sacrifice to the God of his father Isaac.

2 And God spoke to Israel in a vision of the night, having said: Jacob, Jacob. And he said: What is it?

3 saying: I am the God of your fathers; do not be afraid to go down into Egypt, for there I will make you into a great nation.

4 And I will go down with you into Egypt, and I will bring you up to the end, and Joseph will lay his hands upon your eyes.

5 And Jacob arose from the Well of the Oath, and the sons of Israel took up their father and their baggage and their women upon the wagons that Joseph had sent to carry him.

6 And taking up their possessions and all the property that they had acquired in the land of Chanaan, they entered into Egypt, Jacob and all his seed with him,

7 sons and the sons of his sons with him, daughters and the daughters of his sons; and he brought all his seed into Egypt.

8 And these are the names of the sons of Israel who entered into Egypt, Jacob and his sons: the firstborn of Jacob, Reuben.

9 And the sons of Reuben: Enoch and Phallous, Asron and Charmi.

10 And the sons of Symeon: Jemouel and Jamin and Aod and Jachin and Saar and Saul, the son of the Chanaanite woman.

11 And the sons of Levi: Gerson, Kaath, and Merari.

12 And the sons of Judas: Er and Aunan and Selom and Phares and Zara; and Er and Aunan died in the land of Chanaan. And the sons of Phares were Asron and Jemouel.

13 And the sons of Issachar: Thola and Phoua and Jasoub and Zambram.

14 And the sons of Zabulon: Sered and Allon and Aloel.

15 These are the sons of Leia whom she bore to Jacob in Mesopotamia of Syria, and Dina his daughter; all the souls, sons and daughters, were thirty-three. –

16 And the sons of Gad: Saphon and Aggis and Saunis and Thasoban and Aedis and Aroedis and Aroelis.

17 And the sons of Aser: Jemna and Jesoua and Jeoul and Baria, and Sara their sister. And the sons of Baria: Chobor and Melchiel.

18 These are the sons of Zelpha, whom Laban gave to Leia his daughter, who bore these to Jacob, sixteen souls. –

19 And the sons of Rachel, the woman of Jacob: Joseph and Benjamin.

20 And sons were born to Joseph in the land of Egypt, whom Asenneth the daughter of Petephre, priest of the City of the Sun, bore to him: Manasse and Ephraim. And sons were born to Manasse, whom his Syrian concubine bore to him: Machir; and Machir begot Galaad. And the sons of Ephraim, the brother of Manasse: Soutalaam and Taam. And the sons of Soutalaam: Edem.

21 And the sons of Benjamin: Bala and Chobor and Asbel. And the sons of Bala were Gera and Noeman and Anchis and Ros and Mamphin and Ophimin; and Gera begot Arad.

22 These are the sons of Rachel whom she bore to Jacob; all the souls were eighteen. –

23 And the sons of Dan: Asom.

24 And the sons of Nephthali: Asiel and Goyni and Issaar and Syllem.

25 These are the sons of Balla, whom Laban gave to Rachel his daughter, who bore these to Jacob; all the souls were seven. –

26 And all the souls who entered with Jacob into Egypt, those who came out from his thighs, apart from the women of the sons of Jacob—all the souls were sixty-six.

27 And the sons of Joseph who were born to him in the land of Egypt were nine souls. All the souls of the house of Jacob who entered into Egypt were seventy-five.

28 And he sent Judas before him to Joseph to meet him by the City of Heroes, into the land of Ramesses.

29 And Joseph yoked his chariots and went up to meet Israel his father by the City of Heroes, and when he appeared to him, he fell upon his neck and wept with greater weeping.

30 And Israel said to Joseph: I will die from now on, since I have seen your face, for you are still living.

31 And Joseph said to his brothers: I will go up and report to Pharao and say to him: My brothers and the house of my father, who were in the land of Chanaan, have come to me.

32 And the men are shepherds—for they were men who raise livestock—and they have brought the livestock and the cattle and all that is theirs.

33 Therefore, if Pharao calls you and says to you: What is your occupation?

34 then you shall say: We your servants are men who raise livestock, from childhood until now, both we and our fathers, so that you may dwell in the land of Gesem in Arabia; for every shepherd of sheep is an abomination to the Egyptians.

Chapter 47

1 And Joseph came and reported to Pharao, saying: My father and my brothers and their livestock and cattle and all that is theirs have come from the land of Chanaan, and behold, they are in the land of Gesem.

2 And he took five men from among his brothers and stood them before Pharao.

3 And Pharao said to the brothers of Joseph: What is your occupation? And they said to Pharao: Your servants are shepherds of sheep, both we and our fathers.

4 And they said to Pharao: We have come to sojourn in the land, for there is no pasture for the livestock of your servants, for the famine has grown strong in the land of Chanaan; now therefore, we your servants will dwell in the land of Gesem.

5 And Pharao said to Joseph: Let them dwell in the land of Gesem; and if you know that there are capable men among them, appoint them rulers of my livestock. And Jacob and his sons came into Egypt to Joseph, and Pharao king of Egypt heard. And Pharao spoke to Joseph, saying: Your father and your brothers have come to you.

6 Behold, the land of Egypt is before you; settle your father and your brothers in the best land.

7 And Joseph brought in Jacob his father and stood him before Pharao, and Jacob blessed Pharao.

8 And Pharao said to Jacob: How many are the years of the days of your life?

9 And Jacob said to Pharao: The days of the years of my life in which I sojourn are a hundred thirty years. Few and evil have been the days of the years of my life; they have not reached the days of the years of the life of my fathers, the days in which they sojourned.

10 And Jacob blessed Pharao and went out from him.

11 And Joseph settled his father and his brothers and gave them a holding in the land of Egypt, in the best land, in the land of Ramesses, just as Pharao commanded.

12 And Joseph measured grain to his father and his brothers and all the house of his father, grain according to each body.

13 And there was no grain in all the land, for the famine grew exceedingly strong; and the land of Egypt and the land of Chanaan failed because of the famine.

14 And Joseph gathered all the silver found in the land of Egypt and in the land of Chanaan for the grain that they were buying and that he was measuring to them, and Joseph brought all the silver into the house of Pharao.

15 And all the silver from the land of Egypt and from the land of Chanaan failed. And all the Egyptians came to Joseph, saying: Give us breads, and why should we die before you? For our silver has failed.

16 And Joseph said to them: Bring your livestock, and I will give you breads in exchange for your livestock, if the silver has failed.

17 And they brought the livestock to Joseph, and Joseph gave them breads in exchange for the horses and in exchange for the sheep and in exchange for the cattle and in exchange for the donkeys, and he nourished them with breads in exchange for all their livestock in that year. –

18 And that year went out, and they came to him in the second year and said to him: Lest we be destroyed from our lord; for if the silver and the possessions and the livestock have failed to you the lord, then nothing is left for us before our lord except our own body and our land.

19 Therefore, so that we do not die before you and the land is made desolate, acquire us and our land in exchange for breads, and we and our land will be servants of Pharao. Give seed so that we may sow and live and not die, and the land will not be made desolate.

20 And Joseph acquired all the land of the Egyptians for Pharao, for the Egyptians sold their land to Pharao because the famine prevailed over them; and the land became Pharao’s.

21 And he enslaved the people to him as servants, from the extremities of the boundaries of Egypt as far as the extremities,

22 apart from the land of the priests alone; Joseph did not acquire this, for Pharao gave a gift to the priests as an allowance, and they ate the allowance that Pharao gave them; because of this, they did not sell their land.

23 And Joseph said to all the Egyptians: Behold, today I have acquired you and your land for Pharao; take seed for yourselves and sow the land.

24 And it shall be that of its produce you will give the fifth part to Pharao, but the four parts will be for you yourselves, for seed for the land and for food for you and all those in your houses.

25 And they said: You have saved us; we have found grace before our lord, and we will be servants of Pharao.

26 And Joseph set it for them as an ordinance until this day over the land of Egypt, to give a fifth to Pharao, apart from the land of the priests alone; it was not Pharao’s.

27 And Israel dwelt in the land of Egypt upon the land of Gesem, and they inherited upon it and increased and multiplied exceedingly. –

28 And Jacob lived on in the land of Egypt for seventeen years; and the days of Jacob, the years of his life, were a hundred forty-seven years.

29 And the days of Israel drew near for him to die, and he called his son Joseph and said to him: If I have found grace before you, put your hand under my thigh and do mercy and truth with me, that you not bury me in Egypt.

30 But I will sleep with my fathers, and you will carry me from Egypt and bury me in their tomb. And he said: I will do according to your word.

31 And he said: Swear to me. And he swore to him. And Israel bowed down upon the tip of his staff.

Chapter 48

1 And it happened after these words that it was reported to Joseph: Your father is ill. And taking his two sons, Manasse and Ephraim, he came to Jacob.

2 And it was reported to Jacob, saying: Behold, your son Joseph is coming to you. And Israel strengthened himself and sat upon the bed.

3 And Jacob said to Joseph: My God appeared to me in Louza in the land of Chanaan and blessed me,

4 and said to me: Behold, I will increase you and multiply you and make you into congregations of nations, and I will give this land to you and to your seed after you as an eternal holding.

5 Now therefore, your two sons who were born to you in Egypt before I came to you in Egypt are mine; Ephraim and Manasse will be mine as Reuben and Symeon.

6 But the offspring whom you beget after these will be yours; they will be called upon the name of their brothers in their inheritances.

7 And as for me, when I was coming from Mesopotamia of Syria, Rachel your mother died in the land of Chanaan as I was drawing near, by the hippodrome, Chabratha of the land, on the way to Ephratha; and I buried her on the road of the hippodrome [this is Bethlehem]. –

8 And Israel saw the sons of Joseph and said: Who are these to you?

9 And Joseph said to his father: They are my sons, whom God gave me here. And Jacob said: Bring them near to me, so that I may bless them.

10 And the eyes of Israel had grown heavy from old age, and he was not able to see; and he brought them near to him, and he kissed them and embraced them.

11 And Israel said to Joseph: Behold, I was not deprived of your face, and behold, God showed me also your seed.

12 And Joseph brought them out from his knees, and they bowed down to him upon their faces upon the ground.

13 And Joseph took his two sons, Ephraim in his right hand, to the left of Israel, and Manasse in his left hand, to the right of Israel, and brought them near to him.

14 And Israel stretched out his right hand and laid it upon the head of Ephraim—but he was the younger—and his left hand upon the head of Manasse, crossing his hands.

15 And he blessed them and said: The God before whom my fathers Abraham and Isaac were pleasing, the God who nourishes me from youth until this day,

16 the angel who delivers me from all evils, may he bless these children; and my name and the name of my fathers Abraham and Isaac shall be called upon them, and may they be multiplied into a great multitude upon the earth.

17 And Joseph saw that his father had laid his right hand upon the head of Ephraim, and it appeared grievous to him; and Joseph took hold of his father’s hand to remove it from the head of Ephraim to the head of Manasse.

18 And Joseph said to his father: Not so, father, for this one is the firstborn; place your right hand upon his head.

19 And he did not wish to, but said: I know, child, I know. This one also will become a people, and this one also will be exalted, but his younger brother will be greater than he, and his seed will become a multitude of nations.

20 And he blessed them on that day, saying: In you Israel will be blessed, with people saying: May God make you as Ephraim and as Manasse. And he placed Ephraim before Manasse. –

21 And Israel said to Joseph: Behold, I am dying, and God will be with you and return you to the land of your fathers.

22 And I give you Sikima as an exceptional portion beyond your brothers, which I took from the hand of the Amorrites with my sword and bow.

Chapter 49

1 And Jacob called his sons and said: Gather together, so that I may report to you what will meet you at the last of the days.

2 Assemble and hear, sons of Jacob; hear Israel your father.

3 Reuben, you are my firstborn, my strength and the beginning of my children, hard to endure and hard, self-willed.

4 You acted outrageously like water; do not boil over. For you went up upon the bed of your father; then you defiled the bedding where you went up.

5 Symeon and Levi are brothers; they brought unrighteousness to completion by their choice.

6 May my soul not come into their counsel, and may my liver not rest upon their conspiracy, because in their anger they killed men, and in their desire they hamstrung a bull.

7 Accursed is their anger, because it is self-willed, and their wrath, because it was hardened. I will divide them in Jacob and scatter them in Israel.

8 Judas, may your brothers praise you; your hands are upon the back of your enemies; the sons of your father will bow down to you.

9 Judas is a lion’s whelp; from a shoot, my son, you went up. Reclining, you slept like a lion and like a whelp; who will awaken him?

10 A ruler will not fail from Judas, nor a leader from his thighs, until the things laid up for him come, and he is the expectation of nations.

11 He binds his colt to a vine and the foal of his donkey to the tendril; he will wash his robe in wine and his wrapping in the blood of a grape.

12 His eyes are gladdened from wine, and his teeth are whiter than milk.

13 Zabulon will dwell by the sea, and he will be by a harbor of ships, and he will extend as far as Sidon.

14 Issachar desired the good, resting between the inheritances.

15 And seeing that the rest was good and that the land was rich, he put his shoulder to labor and became a man who works the land.

16 Dan will judge his own people, as also one tribe in Israel.

17 And let Dan become a serpent upon the road, sitting in ambush upon the path, biting the heel of a horse, and the rider will fall backward.

18 I await the salvation of the Lord.

19 Gad—a raiding party will raid him, but he will raid them at their heels.

20 Aser—his bread is rich, and he will give delicacy to rulers.

21 Nephthali is a loosened stem, bestowing beauty in the produce.

22 A son increased is Joseph, a son increased, envied, my youngest son; return to me.

23 Against him those taking counsel reviled, and masters of arrows held hostility toward him.

24 And their bows were crushed with power, and the sinews of the arms of their hands were loosened through the hand of the mighty one of Jacob; from there is the one who strengthened Israel.

25 From the God of your father; and my God helped you and blessed you with a blessing of heaven above and a blessing of the earth possessing all things, for the sake of the blessing of breasts and womb,

26 the blessing of your father and your mother. It prevailed over the blessings of the permanent mountains and over the blessings of the ever-flowing dunes; they will be upon the head of Joseph and upon the crown of the brothers whom he led.

27 Benjamin is a ravenous wolf; in the morning he will still eat, and by evening he will distribute food.

28 All these are the twelve sons of Jacob, and these things their father spoke to them and blessed them; each according to his blessing he blessed them.

29 And he said to them: I am being added to my people; bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Chettite,

30 in the double cave opposite Mambre in the land of Chanaan, the cave that Abraham acquired from Ephron the Chettite as a possession for a memorial.

31 There they buried Abraham and Sarra his woman; there they buried Isaac and Rebekka his woman; and there I buried Leia,

32 in the possession of the field and the cave that is in it, from the sons of Chet.

33 And Jacob ceased commanding his sons, and lifting his feet onto the bed, he expired and was added to his people.

Chapter 50

1 And Joseph fell upon the face of his father and wept over him and kissed him.

2 And Joseph commanded his servants, the embalmers, to embalm his father, and the embalmers embalmed Israel.

3 And they completed forty days for him, for thus the days of burial are counted; and Egypt mourned him for seventy days.

4 And when the days of mourning had passed, Joseph spoke to the mighty men of Pharao, saying: If I have found grace before you, speak about me in the ears of Pharao, saying:

5 My father made me swear, saying: In the memorial that I dug for myself in the land of Chanaan, there you shall bury me. Now therefore, I will go up and bury my father and return.

6 And Pharao said: Go up; bury your father, just as he made you swear.

7 And Joseph went up to bury his father, and all the servants of Pharao and the elders of his house and all the elders of the land of Egypt went up with him,

8 and all the household of Joseph and his brothers and all his paternal house; but they left the kindred and the sheep and the cattle behind in the land of Gesem.

9 And chariots and horsemen also went up with him, and the encampment became exceedingly great.

10 And they arrived at the threshing floor of Atad, which is beyond the Jordan, and they mourned him with a great and exceedingly strong mourning; and he made mourning for his father for seven days.

11 And the inhabitants of the land of Chanaan saw the mourning at the threshing floor of Atad and said: This is a great mourning for the Egyptians. Because of this he called its name Mourning of Egypt, which is beyond the Jordan.

12 And his sons did so for him and buried him there.

13 And his sons took him up into the land of Chanaan and buried him in the double cave, the cave that Abraham acquired from Ephron the Chettite opposite Mambre as a possession for a memorial.

14 And Joseph returned to Egypt, he and his brothers and those who had gone up with him to bury his father.

15 And when the brothers of Joseph saw that their father had died, they said: Perhaps Joseph may bear a grudge against us and repay us as repayment all the evils that we displayed to him.

16 And they came to Joseph, saying: Your father made us swear before he died, saying:

17 Thus say to Joseph: Forgive them their unrighteousness and their sin, because they displayed evil things to you; and now accept the unrighteousness of the attendants of the God of your father. And Joseph wept while they were speaking to him.

18 And coming to him, they said: Here we are, your household servants.

19 And Joseph said to them: Do not fear, for I am God’s.

20 You planned against me for evil things, but God planned concerning me for good things, so that it might become as today, that many people might be nourished.

21 And he said to them: Do not fear; I will nourish you and your households. And he comforted them and spoke into their heart.

22 And Joseph dwelt in Egypt, he and his brothers and all the household of his father. And Joseph lived a hundred ten years.

23 And Joseph saw children of Ephraim as far as the third generation, and sons of Machir the son of Manasse were born upon the thighs of Joseph.

24 And Joseph spoke to his brothers, saying: I am dying; but with a visitation God will visit you and bring you up from this land into the land that God swore to our fathers Abraham and Isaac and Jacob.

25 And Joseph made the sons of Israel swear, saying: In the visitation with which God visits you, you shall also carry my bones up from here with you.

26 And Joseph died, a hundred ten years old; and they buried him and placed him in the coffin in Egypt.

Exodus

Chapter 1

1 These are the names of the sons of Israel who had entered into Egypt together with Jacob their father—each entered with his whole household—

2 Reuben, Symeon, Levi, Judas,

3 Issachar, Zabulon, and Benjamin,

4 Dan and Nephthali, Gad and Aser.

5 And Joseph was in Egypt. And all the souls from Jacob were seventy-five.

6 And Joseph died, and all his brothers and all that generation.

7 But the sons of Israel increased and multiplied and became abundant and grew exceedingly, exceedingly strong, and the land multiplied them.

8 And another king arose over Egypt who did not know Joseph.

9 And he said to his nation: Behold, the race of the sons of Israel is a great multitude and is stronger than we.

10 Come therefore, let us act craftily toward them, lest they multiply and, whenever war happens to us, these also be added to the adversaries, and having made war against us, they depart from the land.

11 And he set overseers of the works over them so that they might afflict them in the works; and they built fortified cities for Pharao: Pithom and Ramesses and On, which is the City of the Sun.

12 But according as they humbled them, by so much they became more numerous and grew exceedingly, exceedingly strong; and the Egyptians abhorred the sons of Israel.

13 And the Egyptians oppressed the sons of Israel by force

14 and pained their life with hard works, with clay and brickmaking and all the works in the plains, according to all the works with which they enslaved them by force.

15 And the king of the Egyptians spoke to the midwives of the Hebrews, to the one of them whose name was Sepphora, and the name of the second was Phoua,

16 and he said: When you serve as midwives to the Hebrew women and they are about to give birth, if it is male, kill it, but if female, preserve it alive.

17 But the midwives feared God and did not do according as the king of Egypt commanded them, and they kept the males alive.

18 And the king of Egypt called the midwives and said to them: Why is it that you did this deed and keep the males alive?

19 And the midwives said to Pharao: The Hebrew women are not like the women of Egypt, for they give birth before the midwives enter to them; and they were giving birth.

20 And God did well to the midwives, and the people multiplied and grew strong exceedingly.

21 Since the midwives feared God, they made houses for themselves. –

22 And Pharao commanded all his people, saying: Every male that is born to the Hebrews, throw into the river; and every female, keep it alive.

Chapter 2

1 And there was someone from the tribe of Levi who took one of the daughters of Levi and had her.

2 And she conceived and bore a male; and seeing that it was handsome, they sheltered it for three months.

3 But when they were no longer able to hide it, his mother took a basket for him and coated it with asphalt-pitch and put the child into it and placed it in the marsh beside the river.

4 And his sister was watching from far away to learn what would happen to him.

5 And the daughter of Pharao came down to bathe at the river, and her maidens were walking beside the river; and seeing the basket in the marsh, she sent the maiden and took it up.

6 And opening it, she sees a child crying in the basket, and the daughter of Pharao spared him and said: This is one of the children of the Hebrews.

7 And his sister said to the daughter of Pharao: Do you want me to call for you a nursing woman from the Hebrews, and she will nurse the child for you?

8 And the daughter of Pharao said to her: Go. And the young woman went and called the mother of the child.

9 And the daughter of Pharao said to her: Keep this child for me and nurse it for me, and I will give you the wage. And the woman took the child and nursed it.

10 And when the child had grown, she brought him to the daughter of Pharao, and he became a son to her; and she named his name Moses, saying: I took him up out of the water.

11 And it happened in those many days, when Moses had become grown, that he went out to his brothers, the sons of Israel. And observing their labor, he sees an Egyptian man beating a certain Hebrew, one of his own brothers, the sons of Israel.

12 And looking around here and there, he sees no one, and striking the Egyptian, he hid him in the sand.

13 And going out on the second day, he sees two Hebrew men fighting and says to the one doing wrong: Why do you strike your neighbor?

14 And he said: Who appointed you ruler and judge over us? Do you wish to kill me in the manner that you killed the Egyptian yesterday? And Moses was afraid and said: Has this matter thus become manifest?

15 And Pharao heard this matter and sought to kill Moses; but Moses withdrew from the face of Pharao and dwelt in the land of Madiam. And coming into the land of Madiam, he sat upon the well.

16 And the priest of Madiam had seven daughters who were shepherding the sheep of Jothor their father; and coming, they were drawing water until they filled the troughs to give the sheep of Jothor their father a drink.

17 And the shepherds came and drove them away; but Moses arose and rescued them and drew water for them and gave their sheep a drink.

18 And they came to Ragouel their father; and he said to them: Why is it that you hastened to come today?

19 And they said: An Egyptian man rescued us from the shepherds and drew water for us and gave our sheep a drink.

20 And he said to his daughters: And where is he? And why have you thus left the man behind? Therefore call him, so that he may eat bread.

21 And Moses was settled beside the man, and he gave out Sepphora his daughter to Moses as a woman.

22 And the woman conceived and bore a son, and Moses named his name Gersam, saying: I am a sojourner in a foreign land.

23 And after those many days the king of Egypt died. And the sons of Israel groaned because of the works and cried out, and their cry went up to God because of the works.

24 And God listened to their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham and Isaac and Jacob.

25 And God looked upon the sons of Israel and became known to them.

Chapter 3

1 And Moses was shepherding the sheep of Jothor his father-in-law, the priest of Madiam, and he led the sheep beneath the wilderness and came to Mount Choreb.

2 And an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a flame of fire from the bush, and he sees that the bush burns with fire, but the bush was not burned up.

3 And Moses said: Passing by, I will see this great vision, why the bush is not burned up.

4 And when the Lord saw that he was drawing near to see, the Lord called him from the bush, saying: Moses, Moses. And he said: What is it?

5 And he said: Do not draw near here; loosen the sandal from your feet, for the place in which you stand is holy ground.

6 And he said to him: I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob. And Moses turned his face away, for he was reverent about looking directly before God.

7 And the Lord said to Moses: Seeing, I saw the affliction of my people who are in Egypt, and I have heard their cry because of the taskmasters, for I know their pain.

8 And I came down to rescue them from the hand of the Egyptians and to bring them out of that land and bring them into a good and large land, into a land flowing with milk and honey, into the place of the Chanaanites and Chettites and Amorrites and Pherezites and Gergesites and Evites and Jebousites.

9 And now, behold, the cry of the sons of Israel has come to me, and I have seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them.

10 And now come, I will send you to Pharao king of Egypt, and you shall bring my people, the sons of Israel, out of the land of Egypt. –

11 And Moses said to God: Who am I, that I should journey to Pharao king of Egypt and that I should bring the sons of Israel out of the land of Egypt?

12 And God spoke to Moses, saying: I will be with you, and this is the sign for you that I am sending you out: when you bring my people out of Egypt, you will also serve God on this mountain.

13 And Moses said to God: Behold, I will go to the sons of Israel and will say to them: The God of your fathers has sent me to you. They will ask me: What name is to him? What shall I say to them?

14 And God said to Moses: I am the One Who Is. And he said: Thus you shall say to the sons of Israel: The One Who Is has sent me to you.

15 And God said again to Moses: Thus you shall say to the sons of Israel: The Lord, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you. This is my eternal name and a memorial of generations to generations.

16 Therefore go and gather the council of elders of the sons of Israel and say to them: The Lord, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, has appeared to me, saying: With a visitation I have visited you and whatever has happened to you in Egypt.

17 And I said: I will bring you up from the affliction of the Egyptians into the land of the Chanaanites and Chettites and Amorrites and Pherezites and Gergesites and Evites and Jebousites, into a land flowing with milk and honey.

18 And they will listen to your voice; and you and the council of elders of Israel shall enter to Pharao king of Egypt, and you shall say to him: The God of the Hebrews has called us to himself; therefore let us journey a journey of three days into the wilderness so that we may sacrifice to our God.

19 But I know that Pharao king of Egypt will not permit you to journey unless with a mighty hand.

20 And stretching out my hand, I will strike the Egyptians with all my wonders that I will do among them, and after these things he will send you away.

21 And I will give grace to this people before the Egyptians; and when you run away, you will not go away empty.

22 A woman shall ask from her neighbor and her tentmate vessels of silver and gold and clothing, and you will place them upon your sons and upon your daughters, and you will plunder the Egyptians. –

Chapter 4

1 And Moses answered and said: If therefore they do not believe me or listen to my voice—for they will say: God has not appeared to you—what shall I say to them?

2 And the Lord said to him: What is this thing in your hand? And he said: A staff.

3 And he said: Throw it upon the ground. And he threw it upon the ground, and it became a serpent; and Moses fled from it.

4 And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out your hand and take hold of the tail. Therefore he stretched out his hand and took hold of the tail, and it became a staff in his hand,

5 so that they may believe you, that the Lord, the God of their fathers, the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob, has appeared to you.

6 And the Lord said to him again: Bring your hand into your bosom. And he brought his hand into his bosom; and he brought his hand out from his bosom, and his hand became as snow.

7 And he said: Again bring your hand into your bosom. And he brought his hand into his bosom; and he brought it out from his bosom, and again it was restored to the color of his flesh.

8 But if they do not believe you or listen to the voice of the first sign, they will believe you because of the voice of the last sign.

9 And it shall be that if they do not believe you because of these two signs or listen to your voice, you shall take some of the water of the river and pour it upon the dry land, and the water that you take from the river will become blood upon the dry land. –

10 And Moses said to the Lord: I beseech you, Lord, I am not sufficient before yesterday, nor before the third day, nor since you began to speak to your attendant; I am thin-voiced and slow-tongued.

11 And the Lord said to Moses: Who gave a mouth to man, and who made one hard of hearing and deaf, seeing and blind? Is it not I, God?

12 And now journey, and I will open your mouth and instruct you in what you are about to speak.

13 And Moses said: I beseech you, Lord, select another who is capable, whom you will send.

14 And the Lord became angry with wrath at Moses and said: Is not Aaron your brother, the Levite, here? I know that speaking, he will speak for you; and behold, he will go out to meet you, and seeing you, he will rejoice within himself.

15 And you shall speak to him and give my words into his mouth; and I will open your mouth and his mouth and instruct you in what you shall do.

16 And he will speak for you to the people, and he will be a mouth for you, but you will be for him the things pertaining to God.

17 And you shall take in your hand this staff that was turned into a serpent, with which you will perform the signs.

18 And Moses journeyed and returned to Jothor his father-in-law and said: I will journey and return to my brothers who are in Egypt and see whether they are still living. And Jothor said to Moses: Walk in health.

19 And after those many days the king of Egypt died. And the Lord said to Moses in Madiam: Walk; go away into Egypt, for all those seeking your life have died.

20 And Moses took his woman and his children and mounted them upon the draft animals and returned into Egypt; and Moses took the staff from God in his hand.

21 And the Lord said to Moses: As you journey and return into Egypt, see that you perform before Pharao all the wonders that I gave into your hands; but I will harden his heart, and he shall certainly not send the people away.

22 And you shall say to Pharao: Thus says the Lord: Israel is my firstborn son.

23 And I said to you: Send my people away so that they may serve me; therefore, if you do not wish to send them away, behold, I will kill your firstborn son.

24 And it happened on the way, at the lodging place, that an angel of the Lord met him and sought to kill him.

25 And Sepphora took a pebble and circumcised the foreskin of her son and fell at the feet and said: The blood of the circumcision of my child has stood.

26 And he went away from him, because she said: The blood of the circumcision of my child has stood.

27 And the Lord said to Aaron: Journey to meet Moses in the wilderness. And he journeyed and met him at the mountain of God, and they kissed one another.

28 And Moses reported to Aaron all the words of the Lord for which he had sent him, and all the signs that he had commanded him.

29 And Moses and Aaron journeyed and gathered the council of elders of the sons of Israel.

30 And Aaron spoke all these words that God had spoken to Moses, and he performed the signs before the people.

31 And the people believed and rejoiced, because God had visited the sons of Israel and because he had seen their affliction; and the people bent down and bowed.

Chapter 5

1 And after these things Moses and Aaron entered to Pharao and said to him: Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Send my people away so that they may keep a festival to me in the wilderness.

2 And Pharao said: Who is he whose voice I shall hear, so as to send away the sons of Israel? I do not know the Lord, and I will not send Israel away.

3 And they say to him: The God of the Hebrews has called us to himself; therefore we shall journey a journey of three days into the wilderness so that we may sacrifice to our God, lest death or slaughter meet us.

4 And the king of Egypt said to them: Why, Moses and Aaron, do you turn my people away from the works? Go away, each of you to his works.

5 And Pharao said: Behold, now the people are very numerous; shall we therefore make them cease from the works?

6 And Pharao commanded the taskmasters of the people and the scribes, saying:

7 It shall no longer be added to give straw to the people for brickmaking, just as yesterday and the third day; let them journey and gather straw for themselves.

8 And you shall impose upon them the quota of brickmaking that they themselves make each day; you shall take nothing away, for they are idle. Because of this they have cried out, saying: Let us journey and sacrifice to our God.

9 Let the works of these men be made heavy, and let them be concerned with these and not be concerned with empty words.

10 And the taskmasters and the scribes were hurrying them and spoke to the people, saying: Thus says Pharao: I no longer give you straw.

11 You yourselves journey and gather straw for yourselves from wherever you may find it, for nothing is taken away from your quota.

12 And the people were scattered in all Egypt to gather stubble for straw.

13 And the taskmasters were hurrying them, saying: Complete the works required each day, just as also when the straw was given to you.

14 And the scribes of the race of the sons of Israel who had been appointed over them by the overseers of Pharao were flogged, saying: Why did you not complete your quotas of brickmaking, just as yesterday and the third day, and that of today?

15 And the scribes of the sons of Israel entered and cried out to Pharao, saying: Why do you do thus to your household servants?

16 Straw is not given to your household servants, and they tell us to make the brick, and behold, your servants have been flogged; therefore you will wrong your people.

17 And he said to them: You are idle; you are idlers. Because of this you say: Let us journey and sacrifice to our God.

18 Now therefore, journey and work; for the straw will not be given to you, and you will render the quota of brickmaking.

19 And the scribes of the sons of Israel saw themselves in evils when they were told: You shall not leave off the daily requirement of brickmaking.

20 And they met Moses and Aaron coming to meet them as they were going out from Pharao,

21 and they said to them: May God see you and judge, because you made our odor abominable before Pharao and before his attendants, to give a broadsword into his hands to kill us.

22 And Moses returned to the Lord and said: Lord, why did you harm this people? And why did you send me?

23 And since I journeyed to Pharao to speak in your name, he has harmed this people, and you did not rescue your people.

Chapter 6

1 And the Lord said to Moses: Already you will see what I will do to Pharao, for with a mighty hand he will send them away, and with a high arm he will drive them out of his land.

2 And God spoke to Moses and said to him: I am the Lord.

3 And I appeared to Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, being their God, and I did not disclose to them my name, Lord.

4 And I established my covenant with them so as to give them the land of the Chanaanites, the land in which they have sojourned, in which they also sojourned upon it.

5 And I listened to the groaning of the sons of Israel, whom the Egyptians enslave, and I remembered your covenant.

6 Walk; speak to the sons of Israel, saying: I am the Lord, and I will bring you out from the oppression of the Egyptians and rescue you from slavery and redeem you with a high arm and great judgment.

7 And I will take you to myself as a people for me and will be your God, and you will know that I am the Lord your God who brought you out from the oppression of the Egyptians.

8 And I will bring you into the land into which I stretched out my hand to give it to Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, and I will give it to you as an inheritance. I am the Lord.

9 And Moses spoke thus to the sons of Israel, and they did not listen to Moses because of smallness of soul and because of the hard works.

10 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

11 Enter; speak to Pharao king of Egypt so that he may send the sons of Israel away from his land.

12 And Moses spoke before the Lord, saying: Behold, the sons of Israel did not listen to me, and how will Pharao listen to me? And I am speechless.

13 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron and commanded them concerning Pharao king of Egypt so as to send the sons of Israel away from the land of Egypt.

14 And these are the chiefs of their paternal houses. The sons of Reuben, the firstborn of Israel: Enoch and Phallous, Asron and Charmi. This is the family of Reuben.

15 And the sons of Symeon: Jemouel and Jamin and Aod and Jachin and Saar and Saul, the one from the Phoenician woman. These are the paternal families of the sons of Symeon.

16 And these are the names of the sons of Levi according to their families: Gedson, Kaath, and Merari. And the years of the life of Levi were a hundred thirty-seven.

17 And these are the sons of Gedson: Lobeni and Semei, the houses of their paternal family.

18 And the sons of Kaath: Ambram and Issaar, Chebron and Oziel. And the years of the life of Kaath were a hundred thirty years.

19 And the sons of Merari: Mooli and Omousi. These are the paternal houses of Levi according to their families.

20 And Ambram took Jochabed, the daughter of the brother of his father, for himself as a woman, and she bore him Aaron and Moses and Mariam their sister. And the years of the life of Ambram were a hundred thirty-two years.

21 And the sons of Issaar: Kore and Naphek and Zechri.

22 And the sons of Oziel: Elisaphan and Setri.

23 And Aaron took Elisabeth, the daughter of Aminadab, the sister of Naasson, as a woman for himself, and she bore him Nadab and Abioud and Eleazar and Ithamar.

24 And the sons of Kore: Asir and Elkana and Abiasaph. These are the generations of Kore.

25 And Eleazar the son of Aaron took one of the daughters of Phoutiel as a woman for himself, and she bore him Phinees. These are the beginnings of the paternal family of the Levites according to their generations.

26 This is Aaron and Moses, to whom God said to bring the sons of Israel out of the land of Egypt with their force.

27 These are the ones speaking with Pharao king of Egypt, and they brought the sons of Israel out of Egypt; it is Aaron and Moses.

28 On the day when the Lord spoke to Moses in the land of Egypt,

29 the Lord also spoke to Moses, saying: I am the Lord; speak to Pharao king of Egypt as many things as I say to you.

30 And Moses said before the Lord: Behold, I am thin-voiced, and how will Pharao listen to me?

Chapter 7

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Behold, I have made you a god to Pharao, and Aaron your brother will be your prophet.

2 And you shall speak to him everything that I command you, but Aaron your brother will speak to Pharao so as to send the sons of Israel away from his land.

3 But I will harden the heart of Pharao and multiply my signs and wonders in the land of Egypt.

4 And Pharao will not listen to you; and I will lay my hand upon Egypt and bring out with my force my people, the sons of Israel, from the land of Egypt with great vengeance.

5 And all the Egyptians will know that I am the Lord, stretching out my hand upon Egypt, and I will bring the sons of Israel out from their midst.

6 And Moses and Aaron did just as the Lord commanded them; thus they did.

7 And Moses was eighty years old, and Aaron his brother was eighty-three years old, when he spoke to Pharao.

8 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

9 And if Pharao speaks to you, saying: Give us a sign or a wonder, then you shall say to Aaron your brother: Take the staff and throw it upon the ground before Pharao and before his attendants, and it will become a dragon.

10 And Moses and Aaron entered before Pharao and his attendants and did so, just as the Lord commanded them; and Aaron threw the staff before Pharao and before his attendants, and it became a dragon.

11 And Pharao called together the sophists of Egypt and the sorcerers, and the enchanters of the Egyptians also did likewise with their sorceries.

12 And each threw his staff, and they became dragons; and Aaron’s staff swallowed their staffs.

13 And the heart of Pharao grew strong, and he did not listen to them, just as the Lord had spoken to them.

14 And the Lord said to Moses: The heart of Pharao has been made heavy so as not to send the people away.

15 Walk to Pharao in the morning; behold, he goes out to the water, and you shall stand to meet him at the lip of the river, and you shall take in your hand the staff that was turned into a serpent.

16 And you shall say to him: The Lord, the God of the Hebrews, has sent me to you, saying: Send my people away so that they may serve me in the wilderness. And behold, you have not listened until now.

17 Thus says the Lord: By this you will know that I am the Lord. Behold, I strike with the staff in my hand upon the water that is in the river, and it will change into blood.

18 And the fish that are in the river will die, and the river will stink, and the Egyptians will not be able to drink water from the river.

19 And the Lord said to Moses: Say to Aaron your brother: Take your staff and stretch out your hand over the waters of Egypt and over their rivers and over their channels and over their marshes and over all their standing water, and it will become blood. And blood came to be in all the land of Egypt, both in wood and in stone.

20 And Moses and Aaron did so, just as the Lord commanded them; and lifting with his staff, he struck the water that was in the river before Pharao and before his attendants and changed all the water that was in the river into blood.

21 And the fish that were in the river died, and the river stank, and the Egyptians were not able to drink water from the river, and the blood was in all the land of Egypt.

22 And the enchanters of the Egyptians also did likewise with their sorceries; and the heart of Pharao was hardened, and he did not listen to them, just as the Lord said.

23 And Pharao turned and entered his house and did not set his mind even on this.

24 And all the Egyptians dug around the river so as to drink water, and they were not able to drink water from the river.

25 And seven days were completed after the Lord struck the river.

26 And the Lord said to Moses: Enter to Pharao and say to him: Thus says the Lord: Send my people away so that they may serve me.

27 But if you do not wish to send them away, behold, I strike all your borders with frogs.

28 And the river will belch out frogs, and they will go up and enter into your houses and into the private chambers of your bedchambers and upon your beds and into the houses of your attendants and your people and in your doughs and in your ovens.

29 And the frogs will go up upon you and upon your attendants and upon your people.

Chapter 8

1 And the Lord said to Moses: Say to Aaron your brother: Stretch out your staff with your hand over the rivers and over the channels and over the marshes, and bring up the frogs.

2 And Aaron stretched out his hand over the waters of Egypt and brought up the frogs; and the frog was brought up and covered the land of Egypt.

3 And the enchanters of the Egyptians also did likewise with their sorceries and brought the frogs up upon the land of Egypt.

4 And Pharao called Moses and Aaron and said: Pray concerning me to the Lord, and let him remove the frogs from me and from my people, and I will send the people away, and let them sacrifice to the Lord.

5 And Moses said to Pharao: Appoint for me when I shall pray concerning you and concerning your attendants and concerning your people, to make the frogs disappear from you and from your people and from your houses; only in the river will they be left.

6 And he said: Tomorrow. Therefore he said: As you have spoken, so that you may know that there is no other except the Lord.

7 And the frogs will be removed from you and from your houses and from the farmsteads and from your attendants and from your people; only in the river will they be left.

8 And Moses and Aaron went out from Pharao; and Moses cried out to the Lord concerning the appointed limit of the frogs, as Pharao had appointed.

9 And the Lord did just as Moses said, and the frogs died from the houses and from the farmsteads and from the fields.

10 And they gathered them into heaps upon heaps, and the land stank.

11 And Pharao saw that there was relief, and his heart became heavy, and he did not listen to them, just as the Lord had spoken.

12 And the Lord said to Moses: Say to Aaron: Stretch out your staff with your hand and strike the dust of the land, and there will be gnats among both the humans and the quadrupeds and in all the land of Egypt.

13 Therefore Aaron stretched out the staff with his hand and struck the dust of the land, and the gnats came to be among both the humans and the quadrupeds, and in all the dust of the land the gnats came to be in all the land of Egypt.

14 And the enchanters also did likewise with their sorceries to bring out the gnat, and they were not able. And the gnats came to be among the humans and among the quadrupeds.

15 Therefore the enchanters said to Pharao: This is the finger of God. And the heart of Pharao was hardened, and he did not listen to them, just as the Lord had spoken.

16 And the Lord said to Moses: Rise early in the morning and stand before Pharao; and behold, he will go out to the water, and you shall say to him: Thus says the Lord: Send my people away so that they may serve me in the wilderness.

17 But if you do not wish to send my people away, behold, I send the dog-fly upon you and upon your attendants and upon your people and upon your houses, and the houses of the Egyptians will be filled with the dog-fly, and the land upon which they are.

18 And on that day I will distinguish the land of Gesem, upon which my people are, where the dog-fly will not be, so that you may know that I am the Lord, Lord of all the earth.

19 And I will make a distinction between my people and between your people; and tomorrow this sign will be upon the land.

20 And the Lord did so, and the dog-fly came as a multitude into the houses of Pharao and into the houses of his attendants and into all the land of Egypt, and the land was destroyed by the dog-fly.

21 And Pharao called Moses and Aaron, saying: Go and sacrifice to your God in the land.

22 And Moses said: It is not possible for it to be so, for we will sacrifice the abominations of the Egyptians to the Lord our God; for if we sacrifice the abominations of the Egyptians before them, we will be stoned.

23 We will journey a journey of three days into the wilderness and sacrifice to the Lord our God, just as he told us.

24 And Pharao said: I will send you away, and sacrifice to the Lord your God in the wilderness, but do not extend far in journeying; therefore pray concerning me to the Lord.

25 And Moses said: Here, I will go out from you and pray to God, and the dog-fly will go away from you and from your attendants and your people tomorrow. Do not add again, Pharao, to deceive by not sending the people away to sacrifice to the Lord.

26 And Moses went out from Pharao and prayed to God.

27 And the Lord did just as Moses said and removed the dog-fly from Pharao and his attendants and his people, and not one was left.

28 And Pharao made his heart heavy on this occasion also and did not wish to send the people away.

Chapter 9

1 And the Lord said to Moses: Enter to Pharao and say to him: Thus says the Lord, the God of the Hebrews: Send my people away so that they may serve me.

2 Therefore, if you do not wish to send my people away but still retain them,

3 behold, the hand of the Lord will be upon your livestock in the fields, upon the horses and the draft animals and the camels and cattle and sheep: an exceedingly great death.

4 And at that time I will make a distinction between the livestock of the Egyptians and between the livestock of the sons of Israel; not one thing from all that belongs to the sons of Israel will die.

5 And God set a limit, saying: Tomorrow the Lord will do this thing upon the land.

6 And the Lord did this thing on the next day, and all the livestock of the Egyptians died, but none of the livestock of the sons of Israel died.

7 And Pharao saw that none of all the livestock of the sons of Israel had died, and the heart of Pharao became heavy, and he did not send the people away.

8 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying: Take for yourselves hands full of furnace soot, and let Moses sprinkle it toward heaven before Pharao and before his attendants.

9 And let it become dust upon all the land of Egypt, and there will be ulcers upon the humans and upon the quadrupeds, blisters boiling up among both the humans and the quadrupeds and in all the land of Egypt.

10 And he took the furnace soot before Pharao, and Moses sprinkled it toward heaven, and there came to be ulcers, blisters boiling up, among the humans and among the quadrupeds.

11 And the sorcerers were not able to stand before Moses because of the ulcers, for the ulcers came to be among the sorcerers and in all the land of Egypt.

12 But the Lord hardened the heart of Pharao, and he did not listen to them, just as the Lord commanded.

13 And the Lord said to Moses: Rise early in the morning and stand before Pharao and say to him: Thus says the Lord, the God of the Hebrews: Send my people away so that they may serve me.

14 For at this present time I am sending all my encounters into your heart and those of your attendants and your people, so that you may know that there is no other like me in all the earth.

15 For now, sending my hand, I will strike you and your people with death, and you will be destroyed from the earth.

16 And because of this you were preserved, so that I may display my strength in you and so that my name may be proclaimed in all the earth.

17 Still, therefore, you lay hold of my people so as not to send them away.

18 Behold, at this hour tomorrow I rain exceedingly much hail, such as has not come to be in Egypt from the day it was founded until this day.

19 Now therefore, hasten to gather your livestock and whatever is yours in the field, for all the humans and livestock, whatever is found in the field and does not enter a house, when the hail falls upon them, will die.

20 The one among the attendants of Pharao who feared the word of the Lord gathered his livestock into the houses.

21 But the one who did not apply his mind to the word of the Lord left the livestock in the fields. –

22 And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out your hand toward heaven, and there will be hail upon all the land of Egypt, upon the humans and the livestock and every plant that is upon the land.

23 And Moses stretched out his hand toward heaven, and the Lord gave voices and hail, and the fire was running upon the land, and the Lord rained hail upon all the land of Egypt.

24 And there was hail and fire flaming in the hail; and the hail was exceedingly, exceedingly great, such as had not come to be in Egypt since a nation came to be upon it.

25 And the hail struck throughout all the land of Egypt, from human to livestock, and the hail struck every plant in the field, and the hail shattered all the trees in the fields.

26 Only in the land of Gesem, where the sons of Israel were, did the hail not come to be.

27 And Pharao sent and called Moses and Aaron and said to them: I have sinned this time; the Lord is righteous, but I and my people are impious.

28 Therefore pray concerning me to the Lord, and let the voices of God and the hail and fire cease; and I will send you away, and you shall no longer add to remain.

29 And Moses said to him: When I go out of the city, I will spread out my hands to the Lord, and the voices will cease, and the hail and the rain will be no more, so that you may know that the earth is the Lord’s.

30 And as for you and your attendants, I know that you have not yet feared the Lord.

31 And the flax and the barley were struck, for the barley was standing and the flax was seeding.

32 But the wheat and the spelt were not struck, for they were late.

33 And Moses went out from Pharao, outside the city, and spread out his hands to the Lord, and the voices and the hail ceased, and the rain no longer dripped upon the land.

34 And Pharao saw that the rain and the hail and the voices had ceased, and he added to sin and made his heart and the heart of his attendants heavy.

35 And the heart of Pharao was hardened, and he did not send the sons of Israel away, just as the Lord had spoken to Moses.

Chapter 10

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Enter to Pharao, for I have hardened his heart and the heart of his attendants so that these signs may come upon them in succession,

2 so that you may relate in the ears of your children and to the children of your children as many things as I have mocked the Egyptians with, and my signs that I performed among them, and you will know that I am the Lord.

3 And Moses and Aaron entered before Pharao and said to him: Thus says the Lord, the God of the Hebrews: How long do you not wish to show regard for me? Send my people away so that they may serve me.

4 But if you do not wish to send my people away, behold, at this hour tomorrow I bring a great locust upon all your borders.

5 And it will cover the face of the land, and you will not be able to look down at the land, and it will devour all the remainder of the land that was left, which the hail left for you, and it will devour every tree growing for you upon the land.

6 And your houses and the houses of your attendants and all the houses in all the land of the Egyptians will be filled, which your fathers and their forefathers have never seen from the day they came to be upon the land until this day. And Moses turned away and went out from Pharao.

7 And the attendants of Pharao say to him: How long will this be a stumbling block to us? Send the men away so that they may serve their God. Or do you wish to know that Egypt has perished?

8 And they returned both Moses and Aaron to Pharao, and he said to them: Journey and serve your God; but who and who are those journeying?

9 And Moses says: We will journey with the young and the elders, with our sons and daughters and sheep and cattle, for it is a festival of the Lord our God.

10 And he said to them: Let it be so; may the Lord be with you. As I send you, shall I not also send your baggage? See that evil lies before you.

11 Not so; but let the men journey, and serve God, for this is what you yourselves seek. And they drove them out from the face of Pharao. –

12 And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out your hand over the land of Egypt, and let the locust go up upon the land and devour every plant of the land and all the fruit of the trees that the hail left behind.

13 And Moses raised the staff toward heaven, and the Lord brought a south wind upon the land that whole day and whole night; morning came, and the south wind took up the locust

14 and brought it up upon all the land of Egypt, and it settled upon all the borders of Egypt, exceedingly great. Before it no such locust had come to be, and after these things it will not be so.

15 And it covered the face of the land, and the land was destroyed; and it devoured every plant of the land and all the fruit of the trees that had been left by the hail. Nothing green was left among the trees or among any plant of the field in all the land of Egypt.

16 And Pharao hastened to call Moses and Aaron, saying: I have sinned before the Lord your God and against you.

17 Therefore accept my sin still now and pray to the Lord your God, and let him remove this death from me.

18 And Moses went out from Pharao and prayed to God.

19 And the Lord changed it to a strong wind from the sea, and it took up the locust and cast it into the Red Sea, and not one locust was left in all the land of Egypt.

20 And the Lord hardened the heart of Pharao, and he did not send the sons of Israel away.

21 And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out your hand toward heaven, and let darkness come to be upon the land of Egypt, a palpable darkness.

22 And Moses stretched out his hand toward heaven, and darkness, gloom, and storm came to be upon all the land of Egypt for three days.

23 And no one saw his brother for three days, and no one rose from his bed for three days; but for all the sons of Israel there was light in all the places in which they were.

24 And Pharao called Moses and Aaron, saying: Walk; serve the Lord your God. Only leave behind the sheep and the cattle, and let your baggage run away with you.

25 And Moses said: But you also will give us whole burnt offerings and sacrifices that we will make to the Lord our God.

26 And our livestock will journey with us, and we will not leave a hoof behind, for from them we will take to serve the Lord our God; but we do not know what we shall serve to the Lord our God until we come there.

27 But the Lord hardened the heart of Pharao, and he did not wish to send them away.

28 And Pharao says: Go away from me; take heed to yourself not to add again to see my face. On whatever day you appear to me, you will die.

29 And Moses says: You have spoken; I will no longer appear to you face to face.

Chapter 11

1 And the Lord said to Moses: I will bring one more plague upon Pharao and upon Egypt, and after these things he will send you away from here; and when he sends you away, he will drive you out with everything, with an expulsion.

2 Therefore speak secretly into the ears of the people, and let each man ask from his neighbor and a woman from her neighbor vessels of silver and gold and clothing.

3 And the Lord gave grace to his people before the Egyptians, and they lent to them; and the man Moses became exceedingly great before the Egyptians and before Pharao and before all his attendants.

4 And Moses said: Thus says the Lord: About the middle of the night I am entering into the midst of Egypt,

5 and every firstborn in the land of Egypt will die, from the firstborn of Pharao who sits upon the throne as far as the firstborn of the maidservant who is beside the mill, and as far as the firstborn of every livestock animal.

6 And there will be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as has not come to be and such as will no longer be added.

7 But among all the sons of Israel a dog will not growl with its tongue, from human to livestock, so that you may know how greatly the Lord will distinguish between the Egyptians and Israel.

8 And all these servants of yours will come down to me and bow down to me, saying: Go out, you and all your people whom you lead; and after these things I will go out. And Moses went out from Pharao with wrath.

9 And the Lord said to Moses: Pharao will not listen to you, so that multiplying, I may multiply my signs and wonders in the land of Egypt.

10 And Moses and Aaron performed all these signs and wonders in the land of Egypt before Pharao; but the Lord hardened the heart of Pharao, and he did not wish to send the sons of Israel away from the land of Egypt.

Chapter 12

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying:

2 This month is for you the beginning of months; it is the first for you among the months of the year.

3 Speak to all the congregation of the sons of Israel, saying: On the tenth of this month, let them each take a sheep according to their paternal houses, each a sheep according to a house.

4 But if those in the house are too few so as not to be sufficient for a sheep, he shall take together with himself his neighbor who is near him, according to the number of souls; each shall be counted for the sheep according to what is sufficient for him.

5 The sheep shall be perfect, male, a year old, for you; you shall take it from the lambs and the kids.

6 And it shall be kept for you until the fourteenth of this month, and all the multitude of the congregation of the sons of Israel shall slaughter it toward evening.

7 And they shall take some of the blood and place it upon the two doorposts and upon the lintel in the houses in which they eat it.

8 And they shall eat the meats in this night; roasted with fire, they shall eat them with unleavened bread upon bitter herbs.

9 You shall not eat any of them raw or boiled in water, but only roasted with fire, the head together with the feet and the entrails.

10 You shall not leave any of it until morning, and you shall not break a bone of it; but the things left from it until morning you shall burn up with fire.

11 And thus you shall eat it: your loins girded, and the footwear on your feet, and the staffs in your hands; and you shall eat it with haste. It is a pascha to the Lord.

12 And I will pass through the land of Egypt in this night and strike every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from human to livestock, and among all the gods of the Egyptians I will execute vengeance. I am the Lord.

13 And the blood will be for you as a sign upon the houses in which you are there, and I will see the blood and shelter you, and there will not be among you a plague for destruction when I strike in the land of Egypt.

14 And this day will be a memorial for you, and you shall keep it as a festival to the Lord throughout all your generations; you shall keep it as an eternal ordinance.

15 For seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, and from the first day you shall make yeast disappear from your houses; every soul who eats yeast will be utterly destroyed from Israel, from the first day until the seventh day.

16 And the first day shall be called holy, and the seventh day shall be called holy for you; you shall do no servile work on them, except as many things as will be prepared for every soul—this alone shall be prepared by you.

17 And you shall keep this commandment, for on this day I will bring your force out of the land of Egypt, and you shall make this day an eternal ordinance throughout your generations.

18 Beginning on the fourteenth day of the first month, from evening you shall eat unleavened bread until the twenty-first day of the month, until evening.

19 For seven days yeast shall not be found in your houses; every soul who eats something leavened will be utterly destroyed from the congregation of Israel, both among the resident aliens and the natives of the land.

20 You shall not eat anything leavened; in every dwelling place of yours you shall eat unleavened bread.

21 And Moses called all the council of elders of the sons of Israel and said to them: Go away and take a sheep for yourselves according to your families, and sacrifice the pascha.

22 And you shall take a bundle of hyssop and, dipping it in some of the blood beside the door, touch the lintel and both doorposts with some of the blood that is beside the door; but none of you shall go out through the door of his house until morning.

23 And the Lord will pass by to strike the Egyptians and will see the blood upon the lintel and upon both doorposts, and the Lord will pass by the door and will not permit the destroyer to enter your houses to strike.

24 And you shall keep this word as an ordinance for yourself and for your sons forever.

25 And if you enter into the land that the Lord gives you, just as he spoke, you shall keep this service.

26 And it shall be, if your sons say to you: What is this service?

27 Then you shall say to them: This pascha is a sacrifice to the Lord, as he sheltered the houses of the sons of Israel in Egypt when he struck the Egyptians but rescued our houses. And the people bent down and bowed.

28 And the sons of Israel went away and did just as the Lord commanded Moses and Aaron; thus they did.

29 And it happened in the middle of the night that the Lord struck every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of Pharao who sat upon the throne as far as the firstborn of the captive woman who was in the pit, and as far as the firstborn of every livestock animal.

30 And Pharao arose by night, and all his attendants and all the Egyptians, and a great cry came to be in all the land of Egypt, for there was no house in which there was not someone dead.

31 And Pharao called Moses and Aaron by night and said to them: Arise and go out from my people, both you and the sons of Israel; walk and serve the Lord your God, just as you say.

32 And take up your sheep and cattle and journey, and bless me also.

33 And the Egyptians were forcing the people with haste to drive them out of the land, for they said: We are all dying.

34 And the people took up the dough before it was leavened, their kneading bowls bound in their garments upon their shoulders.

35 And the sons of Israel did just as Moses commanded them, and they asked from the Egyptians vessels of silver and gold and clothing.

36 And the Lord gave grace to his people before the Egyptians, and they lent to them; and they plundered the Egyptians.

37 And the sons of Israel departed from Ramesses to Sokchotha, about six hundred thousand men on foot, apart from the baggage.

38 And a great mixed company went up together with them, and sheep and cattle and exceedingly many livestock animals.

39 And they baked the dough that they had brought out of Egypt into unleavened baked cakes, for it was not leavened; for the Egyptians drove them out, and they were not able to remain, nor did they prepare provisions for themselves for the way.

40 And the dwelling of the sons of Israel, which they dwelt in the land of Egypt and in the land of Chanaan, was four hundred thirty years.

41 And it happened after the four hundred thirty years that all the force of the Lord went out from the land of Egypt.

42 It is a night of advance-watch for the Lord so as to bring them out of the land of Egypt; that night is this advance-watch for the Lord, so as to be for all the sons of Israel throughout their generations.

43 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying: This is the law of the pascha: no foreigner shall eat of it.

44 And every household servant of someone, or one bought with silver, you shall circumcise him, and then he shall eat of it.

45 A sojourner or a hired worker shall not eat of it.

46 It shall be eaten in one house, and you shall not carry any of the meats outside from the house; and you shall not break a bone of it.

47 All the congregation of the sons of Israel shall perform it.

48 And if any proselyte approaches you to perform the pascha to the Lord, you shall circumcise every male of his, and then he shall approach to perform it and will be just as the native of the land; no uncircumcised person shall eat of it.

49 There shall be one law for the inhabitant and for the proselyte who approaches among you.

50 And the sons of Israel did just as the Lord commanded Moses and Aaron for them; thus they did. –

51 And it happened on that day that the Lord brought the sons of Israel out of the land of Egypt with their force.

Chapter 13

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Sanctify to me every firstborn, the first-generated that opens every womb among the sons of Israel, from human to livestock; it is mine.

3 And Moses said to the people: Remember this day in which you came out of the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery, for with a mighty hand the Lord brought you out from here; and yeast shall not be eaten.

4 For today you are going out, in the month of the new things.

5 And it shall be whenever the Lord your God brings you into the land of the Chanaanites and Chettites and Evites and Gergesites and Amorrites and Pherezites and Jebousites, which he swore to your fathers to give you, a land flowing with milk and honey, that you shall perform this service in this month.

6 For six days you shall eat unleavened bread, but on the seventh day is a festival of the Lord.

7 You shall eat unleavened bread for the seven days; nothing leavened shall be seen with you, nor shall yeast be yours within all your borders.

8 And on that day you shall report to your son, saying: Because of this the Lord God acted for me as I was going out from Egypt.

9 And it shall be a sign for you upon your hand and a memorial before your eyes, so that the law of the Lord may be in your mouth; for with a mighty hand the Lord God brought you out of Egypt.

10 And you shall keep this law according to the appointed times of seasons, from days to days.

11 And it shall be when the Lord your God brings you into the land of the Chanaanites in the manner that he swore to your fathers and gives it to you,

12 that you shall set apart every male that opens a womb to the Lord; every one that opens a womb from the herds or among your livestock, as many as are born to you, the males, you shall sanctify to the Lord.

13 Every one that opens the womb of a donkey you shall exchange for a sheep; but if you do not exchange it, you shall redeem it. Every human firstborn among your sons you shall redeem.

14 And if your son asks you after these things, saying: What is this? Then you shall say to him: With a mighty hand the Lord brought us out of the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery.

15 And when Pharao was hardened about sending us away, he killed every firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the firstborn of humans as far as the firstborn of livestock. Because of this I sacrifice to the Lord every male that opens a womb, and I will redeem every firstborn of my sons.

16 And it shall be as a sign upon your hand and an immovable thing before your eyes, for with a mighty hand the Lord brought you out of Egypt.

17 And when Pharao sent the people away, God did not guide them by the way of the land of the Phylistiim, because it was near; for God said: Lest the people repent when they see war and return to Egypt.

18 And God led the people around by the way into the wilderness, toward the Red Sea. And in the fifth generation the sons of Israel went up from the land of Egypt.

19 And Moses took the bones of Joseph with himself, for with an oath Joseph had made the sons of Israel swear, saying: With a visitation the Lord will visit you, and you shall also carry my bones up from here with you.

20 And the sons of Israel departed from Sokchoth and encamped in Othom beside the wilderness.

21 And God was leading them, by day in a pillar of cloud to show them the way, and by night in a pillar of fire.

22 The pillar of cloud by day and the pillar of fire by night did not fail before all the people.

Chapter 14

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and let them turn back and encamp opposite the farmstead, between Magdolum and the sea, opposite Beelsepphon; before them you shall encamp by the sea.

3 And Pharao will say to his people: These sons of Israel are wandering in the land, for the wilderness has shut them in.

4 But I will harden the heart of Pharao, and he will pursue after them; and I will be glorified in Pharao and in all his army, and all the Egyptians will know that I am the Lord. And they did so.

5 And it was reported to the king of the Egyptians that the people had fled; and the heart of Pharao and his attendants was changed toward the people, and they said: What is this that we have done, sending the sons of Israel away so as not to serve us?

6 Therefore Pharao yoked his chariots and took all his people away with himself,

7 and he took six hundred chosen chariots and all the horse force of the Egyptians and captains over all of them.

8 And the Lord hardened the heart of Pharao king of Egypt and of his attendants, and he pursued after the sons of Israel; but the sons of Israel were going out with a high hand.

9 And the Egyptians pursued after them and found them encamped beside the sea, and all the horse force and the chariots of Pharao and the riders and his army were opposite the farmstead, across from Beelsepphon.

10 And Pharao was drawing near; and the sons of Israel looked up with their eyes and see, and the Egyptians encamped behind them, and they were exceedingly afraid. And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord.

11 And they said to Moses: Was it because tombs do not exist in the land of Egypt that you brought us out to put us to death in the wilderness? What is this that you did to us by bringing us out of Egypt?

12 Was this not the word that we spoke to you in Egypt, saying: Let us be, so that we may serve the Egyptians? For it is better for us to serve the Egyptians than to die in this wilderness.

13 And Moses said to the people: Take courage; stand and see the salvation from God that he will perform for us today. For in the manner that you have seen the Egyptians today, you shall no longer add again to see them for all time.

14 The Lord will fight for you, and you will be silent.

15 And the Lord said to Moses: Why do you cry out to me? Speak to the sons of Israel, and let them decamp.

16 And you, lift with your staff and stretch out your hand over the sea and rend it, and let the sons of Israel enter into the midst of the sea along the dry land.

17 And behold, I will harden the heart of Pharao and of all the Egyptians, and they will enter after them; and I will be glorified in Pharao and in all his army and in his chariots and horses.

18 And all the Egyptians will know that I am the Lord when I am glorified in Pharao and in his chariots and horses.

19 And the angel of God who was going before the encampment of the sons of Israel departed and journeyed behind them; and the pillar of cloud also departed from before their face and stood behind them.

20 And it entered between the encampment of the Egyptians and between the encampment of Israel and stood; and darkness and gloom came to be, and the night passed, and they did not mix with one another the whole night.

21 And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the Lord drove the sea with a violent south wind the whole night and made the sea dry, and the water was split.

22 And the sons of Israel entered into the midst of the sea along the dry land, and the water was a wall for them on the right and a wall on the left.

23 And the Egyptians pursued and entered after them, all the horse force of Pharao and the chariots and the riders, into the midst of the sea.

24 And it happened in the morning watch that the Lord looked upon the encampment of the Egyptians in the pillar of fire and cloud and threw the encampment of the Egyptians into confusion.

25 And he bound the axles of their chariots and led them with force. And the Egyptians said: Let us flee from the face of Israel, for the Lord fights for them against the Egyptians.

26 And the Lord said to Moses: Stretch out your hand over the sea, and let the water be restored and cover the Egyptians, both the chariots and the riders.

27 And Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and toward day the water was restored to its place; and the Egyptians fled under the water, and the Lord shook the Egyptians off into the midst of the sea.

28 And the water turned back and covered the chariots and the riders and all the force of Pharao who had entered after them into the sea, and not even one of them was left.

29 But the sons of Israel journeyed through dry land in the midst of the sea, and the water was a wall for them on the right and a wall on the left.

30 And the Lord rescued Israel on that day from the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead beside the lip of the sea.

31 And Israel saw the great hand, the things that the Lord did to the Egyptians; and the people feared the Lord and believed God and Moses his attendant.

Chapter 15

1 Then Moses and the sons of Israel sang this song to God and spoke, saying: Let us sing to the Lord, for he has been gloriously glorified; horse and rider he cast into the sea.

2 He became a helper and protector to me for salvation; this is my God, and I will glorify him, the God of my father, and I will exalt him.

3 The Lord crushes wars; Lord is his name.

4 The chariots of Pharao and his force he cast into the sea; chosen riders, captains, he drowned in the Red Sea.

5 He covered them with the sea; they sank into the deep like a stone.

6 Your right hand, Lord, has been glorified in strength; your right hand, Lord, shattered enemies.

7 And by the multitude of your glory you crushed the adversaries; you sent your wrath, and it devoured them like stubble.

8 And through the breath of your anger the water stood apart; the waters congealed like a wall, the waves congealed in the midst of the sea.

9 The enemy said: Pursuing, I will overtake; I will divide spoils; I will fill my soul; I will kill with my sword; my hand will have dominion.

10 You sent your wind; the sea covered them. They sank like lead in violent water.

11 Who is like you among gods, Lord? Who is like you, glorified among holy ones, wondrous in glories, performing wonders?

12 You stretched out your right hand; the earth swallowed them.

13 In your righteousness you guided this people of yours whom you redeemed; by your strength you called them into your holy lodging.

14 Nations heard and became angry; pangs seized the inhabitants of Phylistiim.

15 Then the rulers of Edom hastened, and trembling seized the rulers of the Moabites; all the inhabitants of Chanaan melted.

16 May fear and trembling fall upon them; by the greatness of your arm, let them become stone until your people pass by, Lord, until this people of yours whom you acquired pass by.

17 Having brought them in, plant them on the mountain of your inheritance, in your prepared dwelling place that you worked, Lord, a sanctuary, Lord, that your hands prepared.

18 The Lord reigns for the age and upon the age and still.

19 For the horse of Pharao entered with the chariots and riders into the sea, and the Lord brought the water of the sea upon them; but the sons of Israel journeyed through dry land in the midst of the sea.

20 And Mariam the prophet, the sister of Aaron, took the hand-drum in her hand, and all the women went out behind her with hand-drums and dances.

21 And Mariam began for them, saying: Let us sing to the Lord, for he has been gloriously glorified; horse and rider he cast into the sea.

22 And Moses led the sons of Israel away from the Red Sea and brought them into the wilderness of Sour; and they journeyed three days in the wilderness and did not find water to drink.

23 And they came to Merra and were not able to drink from Merra, for it was bitter; because of this the name of that place was named Bitterness.

24 And the people were grumbling against Moses, saying: What shall we drink?

25 And Moses cried out to the Lord; and the Lord showed him a piece of wood, and he cast it into the water, and the water was made sweet. There he set ordinances and judgments for him, and there he tested him.

26 And he said: If by hearing you hear the voice of the Lord your God and do the things pleasing before him and incline your ear to his commandments and keep all his ordinances, I will not bring upon you any disease that I brought upon the Egyptians; for I am the Lord who heals you.

27 And they came to Ailim, and there were twelve springs of waters and seventy trunks of palm trees there; and they encamped there beside the waters.

Chapter 16

1 And they departed from Ailim, and all the congregation of the sons of Israel came into the wilderness of Sin, which is between Ailim and Sina, on the fifteenth day of the second month after they had gone out of the land of Egypt.

2 And all the congregation of the sons of Israel was grumbling against Moses and Aaron.

3 And the sons of Israel said to them: Would that we had died, struck by the Lord in the land of Egypt, when we sat at the pots of meats and ate breads to fullness, because you brought us out into this wilderness to kill all this congregation with famine.

4 And the Lord said to Moses: Behold, I rain breads for you from heaven, and the people will go out and gather what is for the day, day by day, so that I may test them, whether they will walk by my law or not.

5 And it shall be on the sixth day that they will prepare whatever they bring in, and whatever they gather day by day will be double.

6 And Moses and Aaron said to all the congregation of the sons of Israel: In the evening you will know that the Lord brought you out of the land of Egypt,

7 and in the morning you will see the glory of the Lord when he listens to your grumbling against God; but what are we, that you grumble against us?

8 And Moses said: When the Lord gives you meats in the evening to eat and breads in the morning to fullness, because the Lord listens to your grumbling that you grumble against us—but what are we? For your grumbling is not against us but against God.

9 And Moses said to Aaron: Say to all the congregation of the sons of Israel: Approach before God, for he has listened to your grumbling.

10 And while Aaron was speaking to all the congregation of the sons of Israel, they turned toward the wilderness, and the glory of the Lord appeared in a cloud.

11 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

12 I have listened to the grumbling of the sons of Israel. Speak to them, saying: Toward evening you shall eat meats, and in the morning you shall be filled with breads; and you will know that I am the Lord your God.

13 And evening came, and a quail came up and covered the encampment; morning came as the dew was coming to rest around the encampment,

14 and behold, upon the face of the wilderness was something thin, like white coriander, like frost upon the land.

15 And when the sons of Israel saw it, they said one to another: What is this? For they did not know what it was. And Moses said to them: This is the bread that the Lord gave you to eat.

16 This is the word that the Lord commanded: Gather some of it, each according to those due, a gomor per head according to the number of your souls; each gather with your tentmates.

17 And the sons of Israel did so and gathered, one the much and one the less.

18 And measuring with the gomor, the one with the much had no surplus, and the one with the less had no lack; each gathered according to those due with himself.

19 And Moses said to them: Let no one leave any of it for the morning.

20 And they did not listen to Moses, but some left some of it for the morning; and it boiled forth worms and stank, and Moses was embittered at them.

21 And they gathered it morning by morning, each what was due to him; but when the sun grew warm, it melted.

22 And it happened on the sixth day that they gathered double what was needed, two gomors for one; and all the rulers of the congregation entered and reported to Moses.

23 And Moses said to them: This is the word that the Lord spoke: Tomorrow is sabbaths, a holy rest to the Lord. As many things as you bake, bake, and as many things as you boil, boil; and leave all the surplus in storage for the morning.

24 And they left some of it for the morning, just as Moses commanded them; and it did not stink, nor did a worm come to be in it.

25 And Moses said: Eat today, for today is sabbaths to the Lord; it will not be found in the field.

26 For six days you shall gather; but on the seventh day is sabbaths, because there will be none on it.

27 And it happened on the seventh day that some of the people went out to gather and did not find any.

28 And the Lord said to Moses: How long do you not wish to listen to my commandments and my law?

29 See, for the Lord gave you the sabbaths on this day; because of this he gave you on the sixth day breads for two days. Each of you shall sit in your houses; let no one go out from his place on the seventh day.

30 And the people kept sabbaths on the seventh day.

31 And the sons of Israel named its name man; and it was like white coriander seed, and its taste was like a cake with honey.

32 And Moses said: This is the word that the Lord commanded: Fill the gomor with man for storage throughout your generations, so that they may see the bread that you ate in the wilderness when the Lord brought you out of the land of Egypt.

33 And Moses said to Aaron: Take one golden jar and put a full gomor of man into it, and you shall store it before God for preservation throughout your generations.

34 In the manner that the Lord commanded Moses, Aaron also stored it before the testimony for preservation.

35 And the sons of Israel ate the man for forty years, until they came into inhabited land; they ate the man until they arrived at a part of Phoenicia.

36 And the gomor was a tenth of the three measures.

Chapter 17

1 And all the congregation of the sons of Israel departed from the wilderness of Sin according to their encampments through the word of the Lord and encamped in Raphidin; but there was no water for the people to drink.

2 And the people were reviling Moses, saying: Give us water so that we may drink. And Moses said to them: Why do you revile me, and why do you test the Lord?

3 And the people thirsted there for water, and the people were grumbling there against Moses, saying: Why is this, that you brought us up from Egypt to kill us and our children and livestock with thirst?

4 And Moses cried out to the Lord, saying: What shall I do with this people? Yet a little, and they will stone me.

5 And the Lord said to Moses: Go before this people, and take with yourself some of the elders of the people; and take in your hand the staff with which you struck the river and journey.

6 Here, I stand before you there upon the rock in Choreb; and you shall strike the rock, and water will come out from it, and my people will drink. And Moses did so before the sons of Israel.

7 And he named the name of that place Temptation and Reviling because of the reviling of the sons of Israel and because they tested the Lord, saying: Is the Lord among us or not?

8 And Amalek came and was making war against Israel in Raphidin.

9 And Moses said to Jesus: Choose capable men for yourself and go out and array yourself against Amalek tomorrow, and behold, I will stand upon the top of the hill, and the staff of God will be in my hand.

10 And Jesus did just as Moses told him, and going out, he arrayed himself against Amalek; and Moses and Aaron and Or went up upon the top of the hill.

11 And it happened that whenever Moses raised his hands, Israel was growing strong; but whenever he lowered his hands, Amalek was growing strong.

12 And the hands of Moses were heavy; and taking a stone, they placed it under him, and he sat upon it, and Aaron and Or were supporting his hands, one from here and one from there; and the hands of Moses became supported until the setting of the sun.

13 And Jesus routed Amalek and all his people with slaughter of the sword.

14 And the Lord said to Moses: Write this down as a memorial in a book and give it into the ears of Jesus, because: With an obliteration I will obliterate the memorial of Amalek from under heaven.

15 And Moses built an altar to the Lord and named its name My Lord Is Refuge,

16 because with a hidden hand the Lord wages war upon Amalek from generations to generations.

Chapter 18

1 And Jothor the priest of Madiam, the father-in-law of Moses, heard everything that the Lord did for Israel his own people, for the Lord brought Israel out of Egypt.

2 And Jothor the father-in-law of Moses took Sepphora the woman of Moses after her dismissal,

3 and his two sons; the name of one of them was Gersam, saying: I was a sojourner in a foreign land.

4 And the name of the second was Eliezer, saying: For the God of my father is my helper and rescued me from the hand of Pharao.

5 And Jothor the father-in-law of Moses went out, and the sons and the woman, to Moses into the wilderness where he had encamped at the mountain of God.

6 And it was reported to Moses, saying: Behold, Jothor your father-in-law is coming to you, and your woman and your two sons with him.

7 And Moses went out to meet his father-in-law and bowed down to him and kissed him, and they greeted one another; and he brought him into the tent.

8 And Moses related to his father-in-law everything that the Lord had done to Pharao and the Egyptians for the sake of Israel, and all the toil that had come to them on the way, and that the Lord rescued them from the hand of Pharao and from the hand of the Egyptians.

9 And Jothor was astonished at all the good things that the Lord had done for them, that he rescued them from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of Pharao.

10 And Jothor said: Blessed is the Lord, because he rescued his people from the hand of the Egyptians and from the hand of Pharao.

11 Now I know that the Lord is great beyond all the gods, because of this, because they set themselves upon them.

12 And Jothor the father-in-law of Moses took whole burnt offerings and sacrifices for God; and Aaron and all the elders of Israel came to eat bread together with the father-in-law of Moses before God.

13 And it happened after the next day that Moses sat together to judge the people; and all the people stood beside Moses from morning until evening.

14 And Jothor saw everything that he was doing for the people and says: What is this that you are doing for the people? Why do you sit alone, but all the people stand beside you from morning until afternoon?

15 And Moses says to his father-in-law: Because the people come to me to seek judgment from God.

16 For whenever a dispute comes to be for them and they come to me, I judge each and instruct them in the ordinances of God and his law.

17 And the father-in-law of Moses said to him: You do not do this thing rightly.

18 With destruction you will be utterly destroyed by something unbearable, both you and all this people who are with you. This matter is heavy for you; you will not be able to do it alone.

19 Now therefore, listen to me, and I will counsel you, and God will be with you. You be for the people the things pertaining to God, and you shall bring their words to God.

20 And you shall testify to them the ordinances of God and his law and indicate to them the ways in which they will journey and the works that they will do.

21 And look out for yourself from all the people capable men who fear God, righteous men who hate pride, and you shall appoint them over them as rulers of thousands and rulers of hundreds and rulers of fifties and rulers of tens.

22 And they will judge the people at every hour; but the weighty matter they will bring to you, and the short judgments they will judge themselves, and they will lighten it from you and help you.

23 If you do this thing, God will strengthen you, and you will be able to stand, and all this people will come to their own place with peace.

24 And Moses listened to the voice of his father-in-law and did as many things as he told him.

25 And Moses chose capable men from all Israel and made them rulers of thousands and rulers of hundreds and rulers of fifties and rulers of tens over them.

26 And they judged the people at every hour; but every weighty matter they brought to Moses, and every light matter they judged themselves.

27 And Moses sent his own father-in-law away, and he went away into his land.

Chapter 19

1 And in the third month of the exodus of the sons of Israel from the land of Egypt, on this day, they came into the wilderness of Sina.

2 And they departed from Raphidin and came into the wilderness of Sina, and Israel encamped there opposite the mountain.

3 And Moses went up into the mountain of God; and God called him from the mountain, saying: Thus you shall speak to the house of Jacob and report to the sons of Israel:

4 You yourselves have seen as many things as I have done to the Egyptians, and I took you up as though upon wings of eagles and brought you to myself.

5 And now, if by hearing you hear my voice and keep my covenant, you will be for me a peculiar people from all the nations, for all the earth is mine.

6 And you will be for me a royal priesthood and a holy nation. These are the words that you shall speak to the sons of Israel.

7 And Moses came and called the elders of the people and set before them all these words that God had commanded him.

8 And all the people answered with one accord and said: Everything that God said we will do, and we will hear. And Moses brought the words of the people to God.

9 And the Lord said to Moses: Behold, I am coming to you in a pillar of cloud, so that the people may hear me speaking to you and may believe you forever. And Moses reported the words of the people to the Lord.

10 And the Lord said to Moses: Go down and testify to the people and purify them today and tomorrow, and let them wash their garments.

11 And let them be ready for the third day, for on the third day the Lord will come down upon Mount Sina before all the people.

12 And you shall mark off the people all around, saying: Take heed to yourselves not to go up into the mountain or touch any part of it; everyone who touches the mountain will die by death.

13 A hand shall not touch him, for he will be stoned with stones or shot down with a missile; whether livestock animal or human, he shall not live. When the voices and the trumpets and the cloud depart from the mountain, those shall go up upon the mountain.

14 And Moses went down from the mountain to the people and sanctified them, and they washed their garments.

15 And he said to the people: Become ready for three days; do not approach a woman.

16 And it happened on the third day, when it became near dawn, that there were voices and lightning and a dark cloud upon Mount Sina; the sound of the trumpet sounded loudly, and all the people in the encampment were terrified.

17 And Moses brought the people out from the encampment to meet God, and they stood beneath the mountain.

18 And all Mount Sina was smoking because God had come down upon it in fire, and the smoke was rising like the smoke of a furnace, and all the people were exceedingly astonished.

19 And the sounds of the trumpet were advancing, exceedingly stronger; Moses was speaking, and God was answering him by a voice.

20 And the Lord came down upon Mount Sina, upon the top of the mountain; and the Lord called Moses to the top of the mountain, and Moses went up.

21 And God spoke to Moses, saying: Go down and testify to the people, lest they draw near to God to observe and a multitude of them fall.

22 And let the priests who draw near to the Lord God be sanctified, lest the Lord destroy some from among them.

23 And Moses said to God: The people will not be able to go up to Mount Sina, for you testified to us, saying: Mark off the mountain and sanctify it.

24 And the Lord said to him: Walk; go down and come up, you and Aaron with you. But let not the priests and the people force their way to go up to God, lest the Lord destroy some from among them.

25 And Moses went down to the people and spoke to them.

Chapter 20

1 And the Lord spoke all these words, saying:

2 I am the Lord your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery.

3 There shall be no other gods for you except me. –

4 You shall not make for yourself an idol or any likeness of as many things as are in heaven above and as many things as are on the earth below and as many things as are in the waters beneath the earth.

5 You shall not bow down to them, nor shall you ever serve them, for I am the Lord your God, a jealous God, repaying the sins of fathers upon children as far as the third and fourth generation to those who hate me,

6 and doing mercy to thousands, to those who love me and those who keep my ordinances. –

7 You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain, for the Lord will certainly not cleanse the one who takes his name in vain. –

8 Remember the day of the sabbaths, to sanctify it.

9 For six days you shall labor and do all your works.

10 But on the seventh day are sabbaths to the Lord your God. You shall not do any work on it, you and your son and your daughter, your servant and your female servant, your ox and your draft animal and all your livestock and the proselyte who sojourns within you.

11 For in six days the Lord made heaven and earth and the sea and everything in them, and he rested on the seventh day; because of this the Lord blessed the seventh day and sanctified it. –

12 Honor your father and mother, so that it may become well for you and so that you may become long-lived upon the good land that the Lord your God gives you. –

13 You shall not commit adultery. –

14 You shall not steal. –

15 You shall not murder. –

16 You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor, false testimony. –

17 You shall not desire the woman of your neighbor. You shall not desire the house of your neighbor, nor his field, nor his servant, nor his female servant, nor his ox, nor his draft animal, nor any of his livestock, nor as many things as belong to your neighbor.

18 And all the people were seeing the voice and the flashes and the voice of the trumpet and the smoking mountain; and being afraid, all the people stood far away.

19 And they said to Moses: You speak to us, and do not let God speak to us, lest we die.

20 And Moses says to them: Take courage, for God has come to you for the sake of testing you, so that his fear may be among you, so that you do not sin.

21 And the people stood far away, but Moses entered into the gloom where God was.

22 And the Lord said to Moses: Thus you shall speak to the house of Jacob and report to the sons of Israel: You have seen that I have spoken to you from heaven.

23 You shall not make silver gods for yourselves, and you shall not make golden gods for yourselves.

24 You shall make an altar of earth for me and sacrifice upon it your whole burnt offerings and your salvation offerings, your sheep and your calves, in every place where I name my name there; and I will come to you and bless you.

25 But if you make an altar of stones for me, you shall not build them hewn, for you have laid your dagger upon them, and they have been defiled.

26 You shall not go up by steps upon my altar, so that you do not uncover your indecency upon it.

Chapter 21

1 And these are the ordinances which you shall set before them.

2 If you acquire a Hebrew servant, he shall serve you six years; but in the seventh year he shall go away free, without payment.

3 If he enters alone, he shall also go out alone; but if a woman enters with him, the woman shall also go out with him.

4 But if his master gives him a woman, and she bears him sons or daughters, the woman and the children shall belong to his master, but he alone shall go out.

5 But if the servant, answering, says: I have loved my master and the woman and the children; I do not run away free;

6 his master shall bring him to the judgment seat of God and then shall bring him to the door, to the doorpost, and his master shall pierce his ear with the awl, and he shall serve him for the age. –

7 But if anyone sells his own daughter as a household servant, she shall not go away as the female slaves run away.

8 If she does not please her master, to whom he had agreed upon her for himself, he shall ransom her; but he has no authority to sell her to a foreign nation, because he dealt faithlessly with her.

9 But if he agrees upon her for his son, he shall do for her according to the ordinance of daughters.

10 But if he takes another for himself, he shall not deprive her of what is due, her clothing, and her marital intercourse.

11 But if he does not do these three things for her, she shall go out freely, without silver.

12 But if anyone strikes someone and he dies, he shall be put to death by death;

13 but if he did not do it willingly, but God delivered him into his hands, I will give you a place to which the killer shall flee.

14 But if anyone sets upon his neighbor to kill him by deceit and seeks refuge, you shall take him from my altar to put him to death. –

15 Whoever strikes his father or his mother shall be put to death by death.

16 Whoever speaks evil of his father or his mother shall end by death. –

17 Whoever steals someone from the sons of Israel and, having overpowered him, sells him, and he is found with him, let him end by death. –

18 But if two men revile one another and someone strikes his neighbor with a stone or with his fist, and he does not die but is laid upon the bed,

19 if the man rises up and walks outside upon a staff, the one who struck him shall be guiltless; only he shall repay his lost time and the medical expenses. –

20 But if anyone strikes his servant or his female servant with a rod, and he dies under his hands, vengeance shall be exacted by judgment.

21 But if he survives one day or two, he shall not be avenged, for he is his silver. –

22 But if two men fight and strike a woman who has a child in the womb, and her child comes out not fully formed, he shall be fined with a fine; whatever the woman's husband imposes, he shall give according to assessment;

23 but if it was fully formed, he shall give life in exchange for life,

24 eye in exchange for eye, tooth in exchange for tooth, hand in exchange for hand, foot in exchange for foot,

25 burn in exchange for burn, wound in exchange for wound, bruise in exchange for bruise. –

26 But if anyone strikes the eye of his household servant or the eye of his female attendant and blinds it, he shall send them away free in exchange for their eye.

27 But if he knocks out the tooth of his household servant or the tooth of his female attendant, he shall send them away free in exchange for their tooth.

28 But if an ox gores a man or a woman and the person dies, the ox shall be stoned with stones, and its flesh shall not be eaten; but the master of the ox shall be guiltless.

29 But if the ox was a gorer before yesterday and before the third day, and they testify to its master, and he does not remove it, but it kills a man or a woman, the ox shall be stoned, and its master shall also die.

30 But if a ransom is imposed upon him, he shall give a ransom for his soul, as much as they impose upon him.

31 But if it gores a son or a daughter, they shall do to him according to this ordinance.

32 But if the ox gores a servant or a female servant, he shall give their master thirty didrachmas of silver, and the ox shall be stoned. –

33 But if anyone opens a pit or quarries a pit and does not cover it, and a calf or a donkey falls there,

34 the master of the pit shall repay; he shall give silver to their master, but the dead animal shall be his. –

35 But if anyone's ox gores his neighbor's ox and it dies, they shall sell the living ox and divide its silver, and they shall divide the dead ox.

36 But if the ox is known to be a gorer before yesterday and before the third day, and they have testified to its master, and he does not remove it, he shall repay ox in exchange for ox, but the dead one shall be his.

37 But if anyone steals a calf or a sheep and slaughters it or sells it, he shall repay five calves in exchange for the calf and four sheep in exchange for the sheep.

Chapter 22

1 But if the thief is found in the breaking-in and, being struck, dies, there is no bloodguilt for him;

2 but if the sun rises upon him, he is guilty and shall die in return. But if he has nothing, let him be sold in exchange for the theft.

3 But if he is caught and the stolen thing is found alive in his hand, from a donkey as far as a sheep, he shall repay them double. –

4 But if anyone grazes down a field or a vineyard and lets his animal graze down another field, he shall repay from his field according to its produce; but if it grazes down the whole field, he shall repay the best of his field and the best of his vineyard. –

5 But if fire goes out and finds thorns and sets fire to a threshing floor or ears of grain or a field, the one who kindled the fire shall repay. –

6 But if anyone gives his neighbor silver or vessels to keep, and it is stolen from the man’s house, if the one who stole is found, he shall repay double;

7 but if the one who stole is not found, the master of the house shall come before God and shall swear that surely he himself has not acted wickedly regarding the whole deposit of his neighbor.

8 For every specified wrongdoing concerning calf and pack animal and sheep and garment and every loss that is alleged, whatever it may be, the judgment of both shall come before God, and the one convicted through God shall repay his neighbor double. –

9 But if anyone gives his neighbor a pack animal or a calf or a sheep or any beast to keep, and it is broken or dies or becomes captive, and no one knows,

10 there shall be an oath of God between both that surely he himself has not acted wickedly regarding the whole deposit of his neighbor; and thus its master shall accept it, and he shall not repay.

11 But if it is stolen from him, he shall repay its master.

12 But if it becomes caught by a beast, he shall bring it to the prey and shall not repay. –

13 But if anyone borrows from his neighbor, and it is broken or dies or becomes captive, but its master is not with it, he shall repay;

14 but if its master is with it, he shall not repay; but if it is hired, it shall be to him in exchange for its hire.

15 But if anyone deceives an unbetrothed virgin and lies with her, with a dowry he shall endow her as a woman for himself.

16 But if her father refuses with a refusal and is not willing to give her to him as a woman, he shall repay silver to the father according to the amount that is the dowry of virgins. –

17 You shall not preserve sorcerers alive. –

18 Everything that lies with livestock—you shall kill them by death. –

19 The one who sacrifices to gods shall be destroyed by death, except to the Lord alone.

20 And you shall not mistreat a resident alien, nor shall you oppress him; for you were resident aliens in the land of Egypt. –

21 You shall not mistreat any widow or orphan;

22 but if with wickedness you mistreat them and, crying out, they cry out to me, I will hear their voice with hearing,

23 and I will be angry with wrath and kill you with the sword, and your women shall be widows and your children orphans. –

24 But if you lend silver to your poor brother beside you, you shall not be one who presses him; you shall not impose interest upon him.

25 But if you take your neighbor’s garment as a pledge, before the setting of the sun you shall return it to him;

26 for this is his covering, this alone is the garment of his nakedness; in what will he sleep? Therefore, if he cries out to me, I will hear him, for I am merciful. –

27 You shall not revile gods, and you shall not speak evil of rulers of your people. –

28 You shall not delay the firstfruits of your threshing floor and winepress; you shall give me the firstborn of your sons.

29 Thus you shall do with your calf and your sheep and your pack animal; seven days it shall be under its mother, but on the eighth day you shall give it to me. –

30 And you shall be holy men to me. And you shall not eat flesh caught by a beast; cast it to the dog.

Chapter 23

1 You shall not accept a vain report. You shall not agree with the unjust person to become an unjust witness.

2 You shall not be with the majority for evil. You shall not join with a multitude to turn aside with the majority, so as to pervert judgment.

3 And you shall not show mercy to a poor person in judgment. –

4 But if you encounter your enemy’s ox or his pack animal wandering, by turning it back you shall return it to him.

5 But if you see your enemy’s pack animal fallen under its load, you shall not pass it by, but you shall raise it together with him. –

6 You shall not distort the judgment of a poor person in his judgment.

7 You shall withdraw from every unjust word; you shall not kill an innocent and righteous person, and you shall not justify the impious person because of gifts.

8 And you shall not receive gifts, for gifts blind the eyes of those who see and ruin righteous words. –

9 And you shall not oppress a resident alien; for you know the soul of the resident alien, for you yourselves were resident aliens in the land of Egypt.

10 Six years you shall sow your land and gather its produce;

11 but in the seventh you shall make a release and leave it, and the poor of your nation shall eat, and the wild beasts shall eat the things left over. Thus you shall do with your vineyard and your olive grove. –

12 Six days you shall do your works, but on the seventh day there shall be rest, so that your ox and your pack animal may rest, and so that the son of your female servant and the resident alien may breathe. –

13 Guard all the things that I have said to you. And you shall not remember the name of other gods, nor shall it be heard from your mouth.

14 Three seasons of the year you shall keep a feast to me.

15 Guard the feast of unleavened bread to perform it; seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, just as I commanded you, at the season of the month of the new things, for in it you came out of Egypt. You shall not appear before me empty.

16 And you shall make the feast of harvest of the first produce of your works, whatever you sow in your field, and the feast of completion at the departure of the year, in the gathering of your works from your field.

17 Three seasons of the year every male of yours shall appear before the Lord your God.

18 For when I drive out nations from your presence and broaden your boundaries, you shall not sacrifice the blood of my sacrifice upon leaven, nor shall the fat of my feast sleep until morning.

19 You shall bring the firstfruits of the first produce of your land into the house of the Lord your God. You shall not boil a lamb in its mother’s milk.

20 And behold, I send my angel before your face, that he may guard you on the way, so that he may bring you into the land that I prepared for you.

21 Attend to yourself and hear him, and do not disobey him; for he will certainly not withdraw from you, for my name is upon him.

22 If by hearing you all hear my voice, and you do all that I command you, and you all keep my covenant, you all shall be to me a special people beyond all the nations, for all the earth is mine; and you all shall be to me a royal priesthood and a holy nation. These words you shall say to the sons of Israel: If by hearing you all hear my voice, and you do all that I say to you, I will be an enemy to your enemies and I will oppose those who oppose you.

23 For my angel shall go, leading you, and shall bring you to the Amorrite and Chettite and Pherezite and Chanaanite and Gergesite and Evite and Jebousite, and I will wipe them out.

24 You shall not worship their gods, nor shall you serve them; you shall not act according to their works, but with tearing down you shall tear down, and with crushing you shall crush their pillars.

25 And you shall serve the Lord your God, and I will bless your bread and your wine and your water, and I will turn sickness away from you.

26 There shall be no barren or sterile one upon your land; I will fulfill the number of your days.

27 And I will send fear leading you, and I will astound all the nations into whom you enter, and I will make all your adversaries fugitives.

28 And I will send the hornets before you, and they shall drive the Amorrites and the Evites and the Chanaanites and the Chettites away from you.

29 I will not drive them out in one year, lest the land become desolate and the beasts of the land become many against you;

30 little by little I will drive them away from you, until you increase and inherit the land.

31 And I will set your boundaries from the Red Sea as far as the sea of Phylistiim and from the wilderness as far as the great river Euphrates; and I will deliver into your hands those settled in the land and drive them away from you.

32 You shall not agree to a covenant with them and with their gods,

33 and they shall not settle in your land, so that they do not cause you to sin against me; for if you serve their gods, these will be a stumbling block to you.

Chapter 24

1 And he said to Moses: Go up to the Lord, you and Aaron and Nadab and Abioud and seventy of the elders of Israel, and they shall worship the Lord from afar;

2 and Moses alone shall draw near to God, but they shall not draw near; and the people shall not go up together with them.

3 And Moses entered and recounted to the people all the words of God and the ordinances; and all the people answered with one voice, saying: All the words that the Lord spoke we will do and we will hear.

4 And Moses wrote all the words of the Lord. And rising early in the morning, Moses built an altar beneath the mountain and twelve stones for the twelve tribes of Israel;

5 and he sent out the young men of the sons of Israel, and they offered whole burnt offerings and sacrificed calves as a sacrifice of salvation to God.

6 And Moses, taking half of the blood, poured it into bowls, but half of the blood he poured toward the altar.

7 And taking the book of the covenant, he read it into the ears of the people, and they said: All the things that the Lord spoke we will do and we will hear.

8 And Moses, taking the blood, scattered it over the people and said: Behold the blood of the covenant that the Lord made with you concerning all these words.

9 And Moses and Aaron and Nadab and Abioud and seventy of the council of elders of Israel went up,

10 and they saw the place where the God of Israel stood; and the things beneath his feet were like a work of sapphire brick and like the appearance of the firmament of heaven in its purity.

11 And not even one of the chosen of Israel was missing; and they appeared in the place of God and ate and drank.

12 And the Lord said to Moses: Go up to me into the mountain and be there; and I will give you the stone tablets, the law and the commandments, which I wrote to legislate for them.

13 And Moses rose, and Jesus who stood beside him, and they went up into the mountain of God;

14 and they said to the elders: Remain quiet here until we return to you; and behold, Aaron and Or are with you; if a judgment happens to anyone, let them approach them.

15 And Moses and Jesus went up into the mountain, and the cloud covered the mountain.

16 And the glory of God descended upon Mount Sina, and the cloud covered it six days; and the Lord called Moses on the seventh day from the midst of the cloud.

17 And the appearance of the glory of the Lord was like a burning fire upon the summit of the mountain before the sons of Israel.

18 And Moses entered into the midst of the cloud and went up into the mountain and was there on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

Chapter 25

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and take firstfruits for me from all those to whom it seems good in their heart, and you shall receive my firstfruits.

3 And this is the firstfruit that you shall receive from them: gold and silver and bronze,

4 and hyacinth and purple and double scarlet and spun linen and goat hair,

5 and red-dyed ram skins and hyacinth-colored skins and incorruptible wood,

7 and sardius stones and stones for engraving for the shoulder piece and the full-length robe.

8 And you shall make a sanctuary for me, and I will appear among you;

9 and you shall make for me according to all that I show you on the mountain: the model of the tabernacle and the model of all its vessels; thus you shall make it.

10 And you shall make an ark of testimony from incorruptible wood, two cubits and a half in length and a cubit and a half in width and a cubit and a half in height.

11 And you shall overlay it with pure gold, outside and inside you shall overlay it; and you shall make twisted golden moldings for it all around.

12 And you shall hammer out for it four golden rings and place them upon the four sides, two rings upon the one side and two rings upon the second side.

13 And you shall make carrying poles of incorruptible wood and overlay them with gold;

14 and you shall insert the carrying poles into the rings on the sides of the ark, to carry the ark with them;

15 the carrying poles shall remain immovable in the rings of the ark.

16 And you shall put into the ark the testimonies that I give you.

17 And you shall make a propitiatory covering of pure gold, two cubits and a half in length and a cubit and a half in width.

18 And you shall make two golden cherubim, worked in relief, and you shall place them on both sides of the propitiatory;

19 one cherub shall be made from this side and one cherub from the second side of the propitiatory; and you shall make the two cherubim upon the two sides.

20 The cherubim shall extend their wings above, overshadowing the propitiatory with their wings, and their faces shall be toward one another; the faces of the cherubim shall be toward the propitiatory.

21 And you shall place the propitiatory upon the ark above; and you shall put into the ark the testimonies that I give you.

22 And I will be known to you from there and will speak to you from above the propitiatory, between the two cherubim that are upon the ark of testimony, and according to all that I command you for the sons of Israel.

23 And you shall make a table of pure gold, two cubits in length and a cubit in width and a cubit and a half in height.

24 And you shall make twisted golden moldings for it all around.

25 And you shall make for it a rim a handbreadth all around; and you shall make a twisted molding for the rim all around.

26 And you shall make four golden rings and place the rings upon the four parts of its feet,

27 beneath the rim, and the rings shall be sockets for the carrying poles, so as to carry the table with them.

28 And you shall make the carrying poles from incorruptible wood and overlay them with pure gold, and the table shall be carried with them.

29 And you shall make its dishes and censers and libation vessels and cups, with which you shall pour libations in them; you shall make them of pure gold.

30 And you shall place upon the table breads set before the face, before me continually.

31 And you shall make a lampstand from pure gold; you shall make the lampstand worked in relief: its stem and branches and bowls and knobs and lilies shall be from it.

32 And six branches shall go out from its sides, three branches of the lampstand from its one side and three branches of the lampstand from the second side.

33 And three bowls shaped like small nuts in the one branch, a knob and a lily; thus for the six branches going out from the lampstand.

34 And in the lampstand there shall be four bowls shaped like small nuts; in the one branch, its knobs and its lilies.

35 The knob beneath the two branches shall be from it, and a knob beneath the four branches shall be from it; thus for the six branches going out from the lampstand.

36 Their knobs and their branches shall be from it; the whole shall be worked in relief from one piece of pure gold.

37 And you shall make its seven lamps; and you shall set the lamps, and they shall shine from one face.

38 And you shall make its oil-drawer and its supports from pure gold.

39 All these vessels: a talent of pure gold.

40 See that you make them according to the pattern shown to you on the mountain.

Chapter 26

1 And you shall make the tabernacle with ten curtains from spun linen and hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet; you shall make them with cherubim, the work of a weaver.

2 The length of the one curtain shall be twenty-eight cubits, and the width of the one curtain shall be four cubits; the same measure shall be for all the curtains.

3 And five curtains shall be holding onto one another, one from the other, and five curtains shall be joined, one to the other.

4 And you shall make hyacinth loops for them upon the edge of the one curtain, from the one part at the joining, and thus you shall make upon the edge of the outer curtain at the second joining.

5 You shall make fifty loops for the one curtain, and you shall make fifty loops from the part of the curtain at the joining of the second; facing one another, they shall meet one another, each one.

6 And you shall make fifty golden rings and join the curtains, one to the other, with the rings, and the tabernacle shall be one. –

7 And you shall make coverings of hair as a cover over the tabernacle; you shall make them eleven coverings.

8 The length of the one covering shall be thirty cubits, and the width of the one covering four cubits; the same measure shall be for the eleven coverings.

9 And you shall join the five coverings together and the six coverings together; and you shall fold the sixth covering double at the face of the tabernacle.

10 And you shall make fifty loops upon the edge of the one covering in the middle at the joining, and you shall make fifty loops upon the edge of the covering that joins the second.

11 And you shall make fifty bronze rings and join the rings from the loops and join the coverings, and it shall be one.

12 And you shall put beneath the excess among the coverings of the tabernacle; the half of the covering that remains you shall cover down, and the excess of the coverings of the tabernacle you shall cover down behind the tabernacle;

13 a cubit from this side and a cubit from that side, from the part of the coverings exceeding the length of the coverings of the tabernacle, shall cover over the sides of the tabernacle on this side and on that side, so that it may cover it.

14 And you shall make a covering for the tabernacle of red-dyed ram skins and upper coverings of hyacinth-colored skins above. –

15 And you shall make pillars for the tabernacle from incorruptible wood;

16 you shall make the one pillar ten cubits, and the width of the one pillar a cubit and a half;

17 two tenons for the one pillar, meeting one another; thus you shall make for all the pillars of the tabernacle.

18 And you shall make pillars for the tabernacle, twenty pillars from the side toward the north.

19 And you shall make forty silver bases for the twenty pillars, two bases for the one pillar for both its parts, and two bases for the one pillar for both its parts.

20 And for the second side, the one toward the south, twenty pillars;

21 and their forty silver bases, two bases for the one pillar for both its parts, and two bases for the one pillar for both its parts.

22 And from the back of the tabernacle, along the part toward the sea, you shall make six pillars.

23 And you shall make two pillars upon the corners of the tabernacle from the rear,

24 and it shall be equal below; in the same manner they shall be equal from the capitals into one joining; thus you shall make for both, let them be for the two corners.

25 And there shall be eight pillars, and their silver bases sixteen; two bases for the one pillar for both its parts, and two bases for the one pillar. –

26 And you shall make bars from incorruptible wood, five for the one pillar from the one side of the tabernacle,

27 and five bars for the pillar on the second side of the tabernacle and five bars for the rear pillar, on the side of the tabernacle toward the sea;

28 and let the middle bar between the pillars pass through from the one side to the other side.

29 And you shall overlay the pillars with gold and make their rings golden, into which you shall insert the bars, and you shall overlay the bars with gold.

30 And you shall erect the tabernacle according to the appearance shown to you on the mountain. –

31 And you shall make a veil from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen; you shall make it a woven work with cherubim.

32 And you shall place it upon four pillars of incorruptible wood overlaid with gold; and their capitals shall be golden, and their four bases silver.

33 And you shall place the veil upon the pillars and bring the ark of testimony there, inside the veil; and the veil shall divide for you between the holy place and between the Holy of Holies.

34 And you shall cover the ark of testimony with the veil in the Holy of Holies.

35 And you shall place the table outside the veil and the lampstand opposite the table, on the part of the tabernacle toward the south, and you shall place the table on the part of the tabernacle toward the north.

36 And you shall make a screen from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen, the work of an embroiderer.

37 And you shall make five pillars for the screen and overlay them with gold, and their capitals shall be golden, and you shall cast five bronze bases for them.

Chapter 27

1 And you shall make an altar from incorruptible wood, five cubits in length and five cubits in width—the altar shall be square—and three cubits in height.

2 And you shall make the horns upon the four corners; its horns shall be from it; and you shall cover them with bronze.

3 And you shall make a rim for the altar and its cover and its bowls and its flesh-hooks and its fire-pan; and you shall make all its vessels bronze.

4 And you shall make for it a bronze grate of network work; and you shall make for the grate four bronze rings upon the four sides.

5 And you shall put them beneath the grate of the altar below; and the grate shall be as far as the middle of the altar.

6 And you shall make carrying poles for the altar from incorruptible wood and cover them around with bronze.

7 And you shall insert the carrying poles into the rings, and let the carrying poles be along the sides of the altar when it is carried.

8 You shall make it hollow, built of boards; according to what was shown to you on the mountain, thus you shall make it.

9 And you shall make a court for the tabernacle; for the side toward the southwest wind, the hangings of the court shall be from spun linen, a length of one hundred cubits for the one side;

10 and their pillars twenty, and their bases twenty, of bronze, and their rings and clasps silver.

11 Thus for the side toward the east wind there shall be hangings, a length of one hundred cubits; and their pillars twenty, and their bases twenty, of bronze, and the rings and the clasps of the pillars and their bases plated with silver.

12 And the width of the court toward the sea shall have hangings of fifty cubits; their pillars ten, and their bases ten.

13 And the width of the court toward the south shall have hangings of fifty cubits; their pillars ten, and their bases ten.

14 And the height of the hangings for the one side shall be fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their bases three.

15 And for the second side, the height of the hangings shall be fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their bases three.

16 And for the gate of the court there shall be a covering, its height twenty cubits, from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen, with the embroidery of a needleworker; their pillars four, and their bases four.

17 All the pillars of the court all around shall be plated with silver, and their capitals silver, and their bases bronze.

18 And the length of the court shall be one hundred by one hundred, and the width fifty by fifty, and the height five cubits, from spun linen, and their bases bronze.

19 And all the construction and all the implements and the stakes of the court shall be bronze.

20 And you, command the sons of Israel, and let them take for you clear, pure, beaten oil from olives for light to burn, so that a lamp may burn continually.

21 In the tabernacle of testimony, outside the veil that is over the covenant, Aaron and his sons shall keep it burning from evening until morning before the Lord; an eternal ordinance for your generations from the sons of Israel.

Chapter 28

1 And you, bring near to yourself both Aaron your brother and his sons from the sons of Israel to serve me as priests: Aaron and Nadab and Abioud and Eleazar and Ithamar, sons of Aaron.

2 And you shall make a holy vestment for Aaron your brother, for honor and glory.

3 And you shall speak to all those wise in understanding, whom I filled with a spirit of perception, and they shall make the holy vestment of Aaron for the holy place, in which he shall serve me as priest.

4 And these are the vestments that they shall make: the breastpiece and the shoulder piece and the full-length robe and a tasseled tunic and a turban and a sash; and they shall make holy vestments for Aaron and his sons, for them to serve me as priests.

5 And they shall take the gold and the hyacinth and the purple and the scarlet and the linen. –

6 And they shall make the shoulder piece from spun linen, the woven work of an embroiderer;

7 two shoulder pieces joining one another shall be for him, hanging from the two parts;

8 and the woven fabric of the shoulder pieces that is upon it shall be of the same workmanship, from it, of gold and hyacinth and purple and finely spun scarlet and spun linen.

9 And you shall take the two stones, emerald stones, and engrave in them the names of the sons of Israel,

10 six names upon the one stone and the remaining six names upon the second stone, according to their births.

11 As the work of the stonecutter’s craft, an engraving of a seal, you shall thoroughly engrave the two stones with the names of the sons of Israel.

12 And you shall place the two stones upon the shoulders of the shoulder piece; they are stones of memorial for the sons of Israel; and Aaron shall take up the names of the sons of Israel before the Lord upon his two shoulders, as a memorial concerning them.

13 And you shall make small shields from pure gold;

14 and you shall make two fringed pieces from pure gold, interwoven with flowers, a work of braiding; and you shall place the braided fringed pieces upon the small shields along their shoulder pieces from the front. –

15 And you shall make an oracle of judgments, the work of an embroiderer; according to the pattern of the shoulder piece you shall make it; from gold and hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen you shall make it.

16 It shall be square, doubled, a span in length and a span in width.

17 And you shall weave into it fabric studded with stones in four rows. One row of stones shall be sardius, topaz, and emerald, the one row;

18 and the second row, carbuncle and sapphire and jasper;

19 and the third row, ligure, agate, and amethyst;

20 and the fourth row, chrysolite and beryl and onyx; covered with gold, let them be bound in gold according to their row.

21 And the stones shall be twelve, from the names of the sons of Israel, according to their names; engravings of seals, each according to the name, let them be for the twelve tribes.

22 And you shall make upon the oracle braided fringes, a work of chainwork from pure gold.

29 And Aaron shall take the names of the sons of Israel upon the oracle of judgment, upon his breast, when he enters into the holy place, as a memorial before God.

29 a And you shall place the fringes upon the oracle of judgment; you shall place the chainwork upon both sides of the oracle, and you shall place the two small shields upon both shoulders of the shoulder piece toward the front.

30 And you shall place upon the oracle of judgment the Manifestation and the Truth, and it shall be upon the breast of Aaron when he enters into the holy place before the Lord; and Aaron shall bear the judgments of the sons of Israel upon his breast before the Lord continually. –

31 And you shall make a full-length undergarment, entirely hyacinth-colored.

32 And its neck opening shall be from it, in the middle, having a border around the neck opening, the work of a weaver, the joining woven together from it, so that it may not tear.

33 And upon the hem of the undergarment below you shall make small pomegranates, as of a blossoming pomegranate, from hyacinth and purple and finely spun scarlet and spun linen, upon the hem of the undergarment all around; and in the same pattern, golden pomegranates and bells between them all around;

34 beside a golden pomegranate, a bell and a flower upon the hem of the undergarment all around.

35 And when Aaron ministers, his sound shall be audible when he enters into the holy place before the Lord and when he goes out, so that he does not die. –

36 And you shall make a plate of pure gold and imprint in it the imprint of a seal: A Holy Thing of the Lord.

37 And you shall place it upon spun hyacinth, and it shall be upon the miter; it shall be upon the front of the miter.

38 And it shall be upon the forehead of Aaron, and Aaron shall bear away the offenses of the holy things, whatever the sons of Israel sanctify, of every gift of their holy things; and it shall be upon the forehead of Aaron continually, acceptable for them before the Lord. –

39 And the tassels of the tunics shall be from linen; and you shall make a linen turban and shall make a sash, the work of an embroiderer.

40 And for the sons of Aaron you shall make tunics and sashes, and you shall make turbans for them, for honor and glory.

41 And you shall clothe Aaron your brother with them and his sons with him; and you shall anoint them and fill their hands and sanctify them, so that they may serve me as priests.

42 And you shall make linen breeches for them to cover the nakedness of their flesh; they shall be from the waist as far as the thighs.

43 And Aaron and his sons shall have them when they enter into the tabernacle of testimony or when they approach to minister at the altar of the holy place, and they shall not bring sin upon themselves, so that they do not die; an eternal ordinance for him and for his seed after him.

Chapter 29

1 And these are the things that you shall do for them to sanctify them, so that they may serve me as priests. You shall take one calf from the cattle and two unblemished rams,

2 and unleavened loaves mixed with oil and unleavened flatcakes anointed with oil; you shall make them from fine wheat flour.

3 And you shall place them upon one basket and bring them upon the basket, and the calf and the two rams.

4 And you shall bring Aaron and his sons to the doors of the tabernacle of testimony and wash them with water.

5 And taking the vestments, you shall clothe Aaron your brother with the full-length tunic and the shoulder piece and the oracle, and you shall join the oracle to the shoulder piece for him.

6 And you shall place the miter upon his head and place the plate, the Holy Thing, upon the miter.

7 And you shall take from the oil of anointing and pour it upon his head and anoint him.

8 And you shall bring his sons near and clothe them with tunics,

9 and you shall gird them with the sashes and place the turbans around them, and the priesthood shall be theirs for me for the age. And you shall perfect the hands of Aaron and the hands of his sons.

10 And you shall bring the calf to the doors of the tabernacle of testimony, and Aaron and his sons shall place their hands upon the head of the calf before the Lord, beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony;

11 and you shall slaughter the calf before the Lord beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

12 And you shall take from the blood of the calf and place it upon the horns of the altar with your finger; but all the remaining blood you shall pour out beside the base of the altar.

13 And you shall take all the fat upon the belly and the lobe of the liver and the two kidneys and the fat upon them and place them upon the altar.

14 But the flesh of the calf and the skin and the dung you shall burn with fire outside the camp, for it is of sin.

15 And you shall take the one ram, and Aaron and his sons shall place their hands upon the head of the ram;

16 and you shall slaughter it, and taking the blood you shall pour it toward the altar all around.

17 And you shall divide the ram limb by limb and wash the inward parts and the feet with water and place them upon the divided parts together with the head.

18 And you shall offer the whole ram upon the altar as a whole burnt offering to the Lord for an odor of sweetness; it is a sacrifice to the Lord.

19 And you shall take the second ram, and Aaron and his sons shall place their hands upon the head of the ram;

20 and you shall slaughter it and take from its blood and place it upon the lobe of Aaron’s right ear and upon the tip of his right hand and upon the tip of his right foot, and upon the lobes of the right ears of his sons and upon the tips of their right hands and upon the tips of their right feet.

21 And you shall take from the blood from the altar and from the oil of anointing and sprinkle it upon Aaron and upon his vestment and upon his sons and upon the vestments of his sons with him, and he shall be sanctified, and his vestment and his sons and the vestments of his sons with him; but you shall pour the blood of the ram toward the altar all around.

22 And you shall take from the ram its fat and the fat covering the belly and the lobe of the liver and the two kidneys and the fat upon them and the right arm—for this is a perfection—

23 and one loaf made with oil and one flatcake from the basket of unleavened things set before the Lord,

24 and you shall place all the things upon the hands of Aaron and upon the hands of his sons and shall separate them as a separation before the Lord.

25 And you shall take them from their hands and offer them upon the altar of whole burnt offering for an odor of sweetness before the Lord; it is an offering to the Lord.

26 And you shall take the breast from the ram of perfection, which belongs to Aaron, and shall separate it as a separation before the Lord, and it shall be a portion for you.

27 And you shall sanctify the breast as a separation and the arm of the removal offering, which was separated and which was removed from the ram of perfection, from Aaron and from his sons,

28 and it shall be an eternal ordinance for Aaron and his sons from the sons of Israel; for this is a removal offering, and it shall be a removal offering from the sons of Israel, from the sacrifices of salvation of the sons of Israel, a removal offering to the Lord. –

29 And the vestment of the holy place, which belongs to Aaron, shall be for his sons after him, for them to be anointed in them and to perfect their hands.

30 For seven days the priest who is in his place from among his sons shall wear them, he who shall enter into the tabernacle of testimony to minister in the holy places.

31 And you shall take the ram of perfection and boil the flesh in a holy place,

32 and Aaron and his sons shall eat the flesh of the ram and the loaves in the basket beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony;

33 they shall eat those things by which they were sanctified, to perfect their hands, to sanctify them; and a foreigner shall not eat from them, for they are holy.

34 But if anything remains from the flesh of the sacrifice of perfection and from the loaves until morning, you shall burn the remaining things with fire; it shall not be eaten, for it is a sanctified thing.

35 And thus you shall do for Aaron and his sons according to all the things that I commanded you; for seven days you shall perfect their hands.

36 And you shall make the calf of sin on the day of cleansing and shall cleanse the altar when you sanctify upon it, and you shall anoint it so as to sanctify it.

37 For seven days you shall cleanse the altar and sanctify it, and the altar shall be holy of the holy; everyone who touches the altar shall be sanctified.

38 And these are the things that you shall make upon the altar: two unblemished year-old lambs each day upon the altar continually, a continual offering.

39 The one lamb you shall make in the morning, and the second lamb you shall make in the evening;

40 and a tenth of fine flour mixed with beaten oil, a fourth of a hin, and a libation of wine, a fourth of a hin, for the one lamb;

41 and the second lamb you shall make in the evening; according to the morning sacrifice and according to its libation you shall make it, for an odor of sweetness, an offering to the Lord,

42 a continual sacrifice for your generations at the doors of the tabernacle of testimony before the Lord, where I will be known to you from there so as to speak to you.

43 And I will appoint myself there for the sons of Israel and will be sanctified in my glory;

44 and I will sanctify the tabernacle of testimony and the altar; and I will sanctify Aaron and his sons to serve me as priests.

45 And I will be called upon among the sons of Israel and will be their God,

46 and they shall know that I am the Lord their God, who brought them out of the land of Egypt to be called upon for them and to be their God.

Chapter 30

1 And you shall make an altar of incense from incorruptible wood; and you shall make it

2 a cubit in length and a cubit in width—it shall be square—and two cubits in height; its horns shall be from it.

3 And you shall overlay them with pure gold, its grate and its walls all around and its horns, and you shall make for it a twisted golden rim all around.

4 And you shall make two pure golden rings beneath its twisted rim; you shall make them on the two sides, on the two flanks; and they shall be clasps for the rods, so as to carry it with them.

5 And you shall make rods from incorruptible wood and overlay them with gold.

6 And you shall place it opposite the veil that is over the ark of the testimonies, among which I will be known to you from there.

7 And Aaron shall burn upon it fine compound incense; morning by morning, whenever he prepares the lamps, he shall burn incense upon it,

8 and whenever Aaron kindles the lamps in the evening, he shall burn incense upon it; an incense of continuity continually before the Lord for their generations.

9 And you shall not offer upon it another incense, an offering, a sacrifice; and you shall not pour a libation upon it.

10 And Aaron shall make atonement upon it, upon its horns, once in the year; from the blood of the cleansing of sins of atonement, once in the year he shall cleanse it for their generations; it is Holy of Holies to the Lord.

11 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

12 If you take the reckoning of the sons of Israel in their visitation, then each shall give a ransom for his soul to the Lord, and there shall not be a fall among them in their visitation.

13 And this is what they shall give, as many as pass through the visitation: half of the didrachma, which is according to the holy didrachma; twenty obols are the didrachma, and the half of the didrachma is an offering to the Lord.

14 Everyone who passes through into the visitation, from twenty years old and above, shall give the offering to the Lord.

15 The one who is rich shall not add, and the one who is poor shall not lessen from the half of the didrachma when giving the offering to the Lord, to make atonement for your souls.

16 And you shall take the silver of the offering from the sons of Israel and give it for the service of the tabernacle of testimony, and it shall be a memorial for the sons of Israel before the Lord, to make atonement for your souls.

17 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

18 Make a bronze washing basin and a bronze base for it, so as to wash; and you shall place it between the tabernacle of testimony and between the altar and shall pour water into it,

19 and Aaron and his sons shall wash their hands and their feet from it with water.

20 Whenever they enter into the tabernacle of testimony, they shall wash with water and shall certainly not die; or whenever they approach the altar to minister and to offer the whole burnt offerings to the Lord,

21 they shall wash their hands and their feet with water; whenever they enter into the tabernacle of testimony, they shall wash with water, so that they do not die; and it shall be an eternal ordinance for them, for him and his generations after him.

22 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

23 And you, take spices: the flower of selected myrrh, five hundred shekels, and half this amount of fragrant cinnamon, two hundred fifty, and fragrant cane, two hundred fifty,

24 and iris, five hundred holy shekels, and a hin of oil from olives,

25 and you shall make it a holy anointing oil, a perfumed ointment by the craft of a perfumer; it shall be a holy anointing oil.

26 And with it you shall anoint the tabernacle of testimony and the ark of testimony,

27 and the lampstand and all its vessels and the altar of incense,

28 and the altar of whole burnt offerings and all its vessels and the table and all its vessels and the washing basin and its base,

29 and you shall sanctify them, and they shall be Holy of Holies; everyone who touches them shall be sanctified.

30 And you shall anoint Aaron and his sons and sanctify them to serve me as priests.

31 And you shall speak to the sons of Israel, saying: This shall be for you a holy oil, an ointment of anointing, for your generations.

32 It shall not be anointed upon human flesh, and according to this composition you shall not make the same for yourselves; it is holy and shall be a sanctified thing for you.

33 Whoever makes the same and whoever gives from it to a foreigner shall be utterly destroyed from his people. –

34 And the Lord said to Moses: Take spices for yourself, stacte, onycha, perfumed galbanum, and transparent frankincense; it shall be equal for equal;

35 and they shall make with them incense, a perfumed work of a perfumer, mixed, pure, a holy work.

36 And you shall beat some of these fine and place it opposite the testimonies in the tabernacle of testimony, from where I will be known to you from there; it shall be Holy of Holies for you.

37 You shall not make incense for yourselves according to this composition; it shall be a sanctified thing for you to the Lord;

38 whoever makes the same so as to smell it shall perish from his people.

Chapter 31

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Behold, I have called by name Beseleel the son of Ouri, the son of Or, of the tribe of Judas,

3 and I have filled him with a divine spirit of wisdom and understanding and knowledge in every work,

4 to devise and to master-build, to work the gold and the silver and the bronze and the hyacinth and the purple and the spun scarlet and the spun linen,

5 and the works of stonecutting and the works of carpentry in wood, to work according to all the works.

6 And I have given him also Eliab the son of Achisamach from the tribe of Dan, and to everyone understanding in heart I have given understanding, and they shall make all the things that I commanded you:

7 the tabernacle of testimony and the ark of the covenant and the propitiatory upon it and the equipment of the tabernacle,

8 and the altars and the table and all its vessels and the pure lampstand and all its vessels,

9 and the washing basin and its base,

10 and the ministering vestments of Aaron and the vestments of his sons for them to serve me as priests,

11 and the oil of anointing and the compound incense of the holy place; according to all that I commanded you, they shall make them.

12 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

13 And you, command the sons of Israel, saying: See that you also keep my Sabbaths; it is a sign with me and among you for your generations, so that you may know that I am the Lord who sanctifies you.

14 And you shall keep the Sabbaths, because this is a holy thing of the Lord for you; the one who profanes it shall be put to death by death; everyone who does work on it, that soul shall be utterly destroyed from the midst of his people.

15 Six days you shall do works, but on the seventh day there shall be Sabbaths, a holy rest for the Lord; everyone who does work on the seventh day shall be put to death by death.

16 And the sons of Israel shall keep the Sabbaths, to perform them for their generations; an eternal covenant.

17 It is an eternal sign in me and the sons of Israel, because in six days the Lord made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he ceased and rested.

18 And when he ceased speaking to him on Mount Sina, he gave Moses the two tablets of testimony, stone tablets written by the finger of God.

Chapter 32

1 And when the people saw that Moses had delayed to come down from the mountain, the people assembled around Aaron and said to him: Rise and make gods for us who shall go before us; for this Moses, the man who brought us out of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him.

2 And Aaron says to them: Remove the golden earrings that are in the ears of your women and daughters and bring them to me.

3 And all the people removed the golden earrings that were in their ears and brought them to Aaron.

4 And he received them from their hands and shaped them with the engraving tool and made them into a molten calf and said: These are your gods, Israel, who brought you up from the land of Egypt.

5 And when Aaron saw it, he built an altar opposite it, and Aaron proclaimed, saying: A feast of the Lord is tomorrow.

6 And rising early on the next day, he offered whole burnt offerings and brought a sacrifice of salvation, and the people sat down to eat and drink and rose to play.

7 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Go quickly from here; descend, for your people, whom you brought out of the land of Egypt, have acted lawlessly;

8 they quickly transgressed from the way that you commanded them; they made a calf for themselves and have worshiped it and have sacrificed to it and said: These are your gods, Israel, who brought you up from the land of Egypt.

10 And now let me be, and being angered with wrath against them, I will wipe them out and make you into a great nation.

11 And Moses entreated before the Lord God and said: Why, Lord, are you angered with wrath against your people, whom you brought out of the land of Egypt with great strength and with your high arm?

12 Lest the Egyptians say: With wickedness he brought them out to kill them in the mountains and to consume them from the earth. Cease from the anger of your wrath and be propitious concerning the wickedness of your people,

13 remembering Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, your household servants, to whom you swore by yourself and spoke to them, saying: I will greatly multiply your seed like the stars of heaven in multitude, and all this land that you said you would give to their seed, and they shall possess it for the age.

14 And the Lord was propitiated concerning the wickedness that he said he would do to his people.

15 And Moses, turning back, came down from the mountain, and the two tablets of testimony were in his hands, stone tablets inscribed on both their parts, written on this side and on that side;

16 and the tablets were a work of God, and the writing is a writing of God carved in the tablets.

17 And Jesus, hearing the voice of the people crying out, says to Moses: A voice of war is in the camp.

18 And he says: It is not the voice of those beginning a song in strength, nor the voice of those beginning a song in defeat, but I hear the voice of those beginning a song in wine.

19 And when he drew near the camp, he sees the calf and the dances, and Moses, angered with wrath, threw the two tablets from his hands and shattered them beneath the mountain.

20 And taking the calf that they made, he burned it in fire and ground it fine and scattered it upon the water and made the sons of Israel drink it.

21 And Moses said to Aaron: What did this people do to you, that you brought a great sin upon them?

22 And Aaron said to Moses: Do not be angry, lord; for you know the impulse of this people.

23 For they say to me: Make gods for us who shall go before us; for this Moses, the man who brought us out of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him.

24 And I said to them: If anyone has pieces of gold, remove them. And they gave them to me; and I threw them into the fire, and this calf came out.

25 And Moses saw that the people had been scattered—for Aaron had scattered them, a delight to their adversaries—,

26 and Moses stood at the gate of the camp and said: Whoever is for the Lord, let him come to me. Therefore all the sons of Levi gathered to him.

27 And he says to them: Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Let each one place his own double-edged sword upon his thigh, and pass through and return from gate to gate through the camp, and let each one kill his brother and each one his neighbor and each one the one nearest him.

28 And the sons of Levi did as Moses spoke to them, and about three thousand men from the people fell on that day.

29 And Moses said to them: You filled your hands today for the Lord, each one with his son or his brother, so that a blessing may be given upon you.

30 And it happened after the morrow that Moses said to the people: You have sinned a great sin; and now I will go up to God, so that I may make atonement concerning your sin.

31 And Moses returned to the Lord and said: I beg, Lord; this people has sinned a great sin and made golden gods for themselves.

32 And now, if you forgive their sin, forgive; but if not, wipe me out from your book that you wrote.

33 And the Lord said to Moses: If anyone has sinned before me, I will wipe him out from my book.

34 But now go, descend, and guide this people into the place that I told you; behold, my angel goes before your face; and on whatever day I visit, I will bring their sin upon them.

35 And the Lord struck the people concerning the making of the calf that Aaron made.

Chapter 33

1 And the Lord said to Moses: Go, ascend from here, you and your people whom you brought out of the land of Egypt, into the land that I swore to Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, saying: I will give it to your seed.

2 And I will send my angel together before your face, and he shall drive out the Amorrite and Chettite and Pherezite and Gergesite and Evite and Jebousite.

3 And I will bring you into a land flowing with milk and honey; for I will certainly not go up together with you, because you are a stiff-necked people, lest I utterly consume you on the way.

4 And when the people heard this evil word, they mourned in mourning garments.

5 And the Lord said to the sons of Israel: You are a stiff-necked people; see that I do not bring another blow upon you and utterly consume you; now therefore remove the vestments of your glories and the adornment, and I will show you what I will do to you.

6 And the sons of Israel removed their adornment and their array from Mount Choreb.

7 And Moses, taking his tent, pitched it outside the camp, far from the camp, and it was called the tabernacle of testimony; and it happened that everyone seeking the Lord went out to the tabernacle outside the camp.

8 And whenever Moses entered the tabernacle outside the camp, all the people stood watching, each one beside the doors of his tent, and they observed Moses departing until he entered the tabernacle.

9 And whenever Moses entered the tabernacle, the pillar of cloud descended and stood at the door of the tabernacle, and he spoke to Moses;

10 and all the people saw the pillar of cloud standing at the door of the tabernacle, and all the people stood and worshiped, each one from the door of his tent.

11 And the Lord spoke to Moses face to face, as if someone would speak to his own friend. And he would depart into the camp, but the attendant Jesus, the young son of Nave, did not go out from the tabernacle.

12 And Moses said to the Lord: Behold, you say to me: Bring up this people; but you have not shown me whom you will send together with me; but you said to me: I know you beyond all, and you have grace with me.

13 If therefore I have found grace before you, reveal yourself to me; let me see you knowingly, so that I may be one who has found grace before you, and so that I may know that this great nation is your people.

14 And he says: I myself will go before you and give you rest.

15 And he says to him: If you yourself do not go, do not bring me up from here;

16 and how shall it be truly known that I have found grace with you, I and your people, except by your going together with us? And I and your people shall be glorified beyond all the nations that are upon the earth.

17 And the Lord said to Moses: I will also do for you this word that you have spoken; for you have found grace before me, and I know you beyond all.

18 And he says: Show me your own glory.

19 And he said: I will pass before you in my glory and will call by my name, Lord, before you; and I will show mercy to whomever I show mercy, and I will have compassion on whomever I have compassion.

20 And he said: You will not be able to see my face; for a man shall certainly not see my face and live.

21 And the Lord said: Behold, there is a place beside me; you shall stand upon the rock;

22 and whenever my glory passes, I will place you in a cleft of the rock and cover you with my hand over you until I pass;

23 and I will remove my hand, and then you shall see my back parts, but my face shall not appear to you.

Chapter 34

1 And the Lord said to Moses: Hew two stone tablets for yourself, just as the first ones, and go up to me into the mountain, and I will write upon the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you shattered.

2 And be ready for the morning, and you shall go up upon Mount Sina and stand there for me upon the summit of the mountain.

3 And let no one go up with you, nor let anyone appear on the whole mountain; and let neither the sheep nor the cattle graze near that mountain.

4 And he hewed two stone tablets just as the first ones; and rising early, Moses went up into Mount Sina, just as the Lord commanded him; and Moses took the two stone tablets.

5 And the Lord descended in a cloud and stood beside him there; and he called by the name of the Lord.

6 And the Lord passed before his face and called: The Lord, the God compassionate and merciful, longsuffering and abundant in mercy and true,

7 and preserving righteousness and doing mercy to thousands, taking away lawlessness and injustice and sins, and he will not cleanse the guilty, bringing the lawlessness of fathers upon children and upon children’s children, upon the third and fourth generation.

8 And Moses, hastening, bowed toward the earth and worshiped,

9 and said: If I have found grace before you, let my Lord go together with us; for the people are stiff-necked, and you shall take away our sins and our lawlessness, and we shall be yours.

10 And the Lord said to Moses: Behold, I establish a covenant for you; before all your people I will do glorious things that have not happened in all the earth and in any nation, and all the people among whom you are shall see the works of the Lord, because the things that I will do for you are marvelous.

11 You attend to all the things that I command you. Behold, I drive out before you all the Amorrite and Chanaanite and Chettite and Pherezite and Evite and Gergesite and Jebousite;

12 attend to yourself, lest you establish a covenant with those settled upon the land into which you enter, lest it become a stumbling block for you among you all.

13 You shall tear down their altars and crush their pillars and cut down their groves and burn the carved images of their gods with fire.

14 For you shall certainly not worship another god; for the Lord God is a jealous name, he is a jealous God.

15 Lest you establish a covenant with those settled with the foreigners upon the land, and they prostitute themselves after their gods and sacrifice to their gods and call you and you eat from their sacrifices,

16 and you take from their daughters for your sons and give from your daughters to their sons, and your daughters prostitute themselves after their gods and make your sons prostitute themselves after their gods.

17 And you shall not make molten gods for yourself.

18 And you shall keep the feast of unleavened bread; seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, just as I commanded you, at the season in the month of the new things; for in the month of the new things you came out of Egypt.

19 Every male that opens the womb is mine: the firstborn of a calf and the firstborn of a sheep.

20 And you shall redeem the firstborn of a pack animal with a sheep; but if you do not redeem it, you shall give its price. You shall redeem every firstborn of your sons. You shall not appear before me empty.

21 Six days you shall work, but on the seventh you shall rest; at sowing and at harvest you shall rest.

22 And you shall make for me a feast of weeks, the beginning of the wheat harvest, and a feast of gathering while the year is midway.

23 Three seasons of the year every male of yours shall appear before the Lord, the God of Israel;

24 for whenever I drive out the nations before your face and broaden your boundaries, no one shall covet your land whenever you go up to appear before the Lord your God three seasons of the year.

25 You shall not slaughter the blood of my incense offerings upon leaven. And the sacrifices of the feast of Pascha shall not sleep until morning.

26 You shall place the first produce of your land in the house of the Lord your God. You shall not bring a lamb in its mother’s milk.

27 And the Lord said to Moses: Write these words for yourself; for upon these words I have established a covenant for you and for Israel.

28 And Moses was there before the Lord forty days and forty nights; he did not eat bread and did not drink water; and he wrote these words upon the tablets of the covenant, the ten words. –

29 And as Moses was coming down from the mountain, the two tablets were upon the hands of Moses; and while he was coming down from the mountain, Moses did not know that the appearance of the complexion of his face had been glorified while he spoke to him.

30 And Aaron and all the elders of Israel saw Moses, and the appearance of the complexion of his face had been glorified, and they were afraid to draw near him.

31 And Moses called them, and Aaron and all the rulers of the congregation turned toward him, and Moses spoke to them.

32 And after these things all the sons of Israel approached him, and he commanded them all the things that the Lord spoke to him on Mount Sina.

33 And when he ceased speaking to them, he placed a covering upon his face.

34 But whenever Moses entered before the Lord to speak to him, he removed the covering until he went out. And going out, he spoke to all the sons of Israel the things that the Lord commanded him,

35 and the sons of Israel saw the face of Moses, that it had been glorified, and Moses placed a covering upon his own face until he entered to speak together with him.

Chapter 35

1 And Moses gathered the whole congregation of the sons of Israel and said to them: These are the words that the Lord said to do.

2 Six days you shall do works, but on the seventh day there shall be rest, a holy thing, Sabbaths, a rest for the Lord; let everyone who does work on it end.

3 You shall not kindle fire in any of your dwellings on the day of the Sabbaths; I am the Lord.

4 And Moses said to the whole congregation of the sons of Israel, saying: This is the word that the Lord commanded, saying:

5 Take from yourselves a removal offering for the Lord; all who accept in the heart shall bring the firstfruits to the Lord: gold, silver, bronze,

6 hyacinth, purple, finely spun double scarlet and spun linen and goat hair,

7 and red-dyed ram skins and hyacinth-colored skins and incorruptible wood,

9 and sardius stones and stones for engraving for the shoulder piece and the full-length robe.

10 And let everyone wise in heart among you come and work all the things that the Lord commanded:

11 the tabernacle and the side curtains and the coverings and the stretchers and the bars and the pillars,

12 and the ark of testimony and its carrying poles and its propitiatory and the veil,

12 a And the hangings of the court and its pillars and the emerald stones and the incense and the oil of anointing,

13 and the table and all its vessels,

14 and the lampstand of light and all its vessels,

16 and the altar and all its vessels,

19 and the holy vestments of Aaron the priest and the vestments in which they shall minister in them and the tunics for the sons of Aaron for the priesthood and the oil of anointing and the compound incense. –

20 And the whole congregation of the sons of Israel went out from Moses,

21 and each brought the things that their heart bore, and as many as it seemed good to in their soul brought a removal offering to the Lord for all the works of the tabernacle of testimony and for all its services and for all the vestments of the holy place.

22 And the men brought from the women; everyone to whom it seemed good in the understanding brought seals and earrings and rings and braided ornaments and bracelets, every golden vessel, and all who brought removal offerings of gold to the Lord.

23 And everyone with whom linen and hyacinth-colored skins and red-dyed ram skins were found brought them.

24 And everyone removing a removal offering of silver and bronze brought the removal offerings to the Lord, and those with whom incorruptible wood was found for all the works of the construction brought it.

25 And every woman wise in understanding to spin with her hands brought the things they had spun: the hyacinth and the purple and the scarlet and the linen;

26 and all the women to whom it seemed good in their understanding, with wisdom, spun the goat hair.

27 And the rulers brought the emerald stones and the stones of filling for the shoulder piece and for the oracle,

28 and the compounds and the oil of anointing and the compound of incense.

29 And every man and woman whose understanding bore them, having entered to do all the works that the Lord commanded to be done through Moses, the sons of Israel brought a removal offering to the Lord.

30 And Moses said to the sons of Israel: Behold, God has called by name Beseleel the son of Ouri, the son of Or, from the tribe of Judas,

31 and filled him with a divine spirit of wisdom and understanding and knowledge of all things,

32 to master-build according to all the works of master-building, to make the gold and the silver and the bronze,

33 and to work stone as a stonecutter and to work the wood and to make every work of wisdom;

34 and indeed he gave it to him in his understanding to teach, both to him and Eliab the son of Achisamach from the tribe of Dan;

35 he filled them with wisdom and understanding of mind, to understand how to make the works of the holy place and the woven and embroidered things, to weave with the scarlet and the linen, to make every work of master-building and embroidery.

Chapter 36

1 And Beseleel and Eliab and everyone wise in understanding, to whom wisdom and knowledge had been given among them to understand how to make all the works according to the holy duties, did according to all that the Lord commanded.

2 And Moses called Beseleel and Eliab and all those possessing wisdom, to whom God had given knowledge in the heart, and all those willingly desiring to approach the works so as to complete them,

3 and they received from Moses all the removal offerings that the sons of Israel had brought for all the works of the holy place to make them, and they still continued to receive the things offered by those bringing them morning by morning.

4 And all the wise people making the works of the holy place came, each according to his own work that they were working,

5 and they said to Moses: The people are bringing an abundance beyond the works that the Lord commanded to be made.

6 And Moses commanded and proclaimed in the camp, saying: Let man and woman no longer work for the firstfruits of the holy place; and the people were prevented from offering any more.

7 And the works were sufficient for them to make the construction, and they left over besides.

8 And everyone wise among those working made the holy vestments that belong to Aaron the priest, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

9 And they made the shoulder piece from gold and hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen.

10 And the plates of gold were cut into threads so as to be woven together with the hyacinth and the purple and with the finely spun scarlet and with the spun linen, a woven work;

11 they made it with shoulder pieces joining from both parts,

12 a woven work braided together with one another, in itself from itself; they made it according to its workmanship from gold and hyacinth and purple and finely spun scarlet and spun linen, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

13 And they made both emerald stones clasped and set around with gold, engraved and carved with the carving of a seal from the names of the sons of Israel;

14 and he placed them upon the shoulders of the shoulder piece, stones of memorial for the sons of Israel, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

15 And they made an oracle, a woven work with embroidery, according to the work of the shoulder piece, from gold and hyacinth and purple and finely spun scarlet and spun linen;

16 they made the oracle square and doubled, a span in length and a span in width, doubled.

17 And fabric studded with stones in four rows was woven into it; one row of stones was sardius and topaz and emerald, the one row;

18 and the second row, carbuncle and sapphire and jasper;

19 and the third row, ligure and agate and amethyst;

20 and the fourth row, chrysolite and beryl and onyx, encircled with gold and bound with gold.

21 And the stones were twelve, from the names of the sons of Israel, from their names, inscribed as seals, each from his own name, for the twelve tribes.

22 And they made braided fringes upon the oracle, a work of braiding from pure gold;

23 and they made two golden small shields and two golden rings and placed the two golden rings upon both ends of the oracle;

24 and they placed the braids of gold upon the rings on both parts of the oracle,

25 and the two braids into the two joinings, and they placed them upon the two small shields and placed them upon the shoulders of the shoulder piece opposite, toward the front.

26 And they made two golden rings and placed them upon the two wings at the edge of the oracle, upon the edge of the rear of the shoulder piece, inside.

27 And they made two golden rings and placed them upon both shoulders of the shoulder piece, below it toward the front, at the joining above the woven band of the shoulder piece.

28 And he fastened the oracle from the rings upon it to the rings of the shoulder piece, held together by the hyacinth and braided into the fabric of the shoulder piece, so that the oracle would not loosen from the shoulder piece, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

29 And they made the undergarment beneath the shoulder piece, a woven work entirely hyacinth-colored;

30 and the neck opening of the undergarment was interwoven and knitted in the middle, having an unbreakable border around the neck opening.

31 And upon the hem of the undergarment below they made small pomegranates, as of a blossoming pomegranate, from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen,

32 and they made golden bells and placed the bells upon the hem of the undergarment all around, between the small pomegranates;

33 a golden bell and a small pomegranate upon the hem of the undergarment all around for ministering, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

34 And they made woven linen tunics for Aaron and his sons,

35 and the turbans from linen and the miter from linen and the breeches from spun linen,

36 and their sashes from linen and hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet, the work of an embroiderer, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses.

37 And they made the golden plate, a separation of the holy place, from pure gold; and he wrote upon it letters imprinted as a seal: A Holy Thing to the Lord;

38 and they placed a hyacinth hem upon it so that it would lie upon the miter above, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses.

Chapter 37

1 And they made ten curtains for the tabernacle,

2 the length of the one curtain twenty-eight cubits—they were all the same—and the width of the one curtain four cubits.

3 And they made the veil from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen, a woven work with cherubim,

4 and they placed it upon four incorruptible pillars overlaid with gold, and their capitals were golden, and their four bases silver.

5 And they made the veil of the door of the tabernacle of testimony from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen, a woven work with cherubim,

6 and its five pillars and the rings; and they overlaid their capitals and their clasps with gold, and their five bases were bronze.

7 And they made the court; the hangings of the court toward the southwest wind were from spun linen, one hundred by one hundred,

8 and their pillars twenty, and their bases twenty;

9 and the side toward the north one hundred by one hundred, and their pillars twenty, and their bases twenty;

10 and the side toward the sea had curtains of fifty cubits, their pillars ten, and their bases ten;

11 and the side toward the east was fifty cubits,

12 hangings of fifteen cubits along the rear, and their pillars three, and their bases three,

13 and upon the second rear, on this side and that side along the gate of the court, curtains of fifteen cubits, and their pillars three, and their bases three.

14 All the curtains of the court were from spun linen,

15 and the bases of the pillars bronze, and their loops silver, and their capitals plated with silver, and the pillars plated with silver, all the pillars of the court. –

16 And the veil of the gate of the court was the work of an embroiderer, from hyacinth and purple and spun scarlet and spun linen, twenty cubits in length, and the height and the width five cubits, equal to the hangings of the court;

17 and their pillars four, and their four bases bronze, and their loops silver, and their capitals plated with silver;

18 and they themselves plated with silver, and all the stakes of the court all around bronze.

19 And this is the arrangement of the tabernacle of testimony, just as it was ordered to Moses for the ministry to belong to the Levites through Ithamar the son of Aaron the priest.

20 And Beseleel the son of Ouri from the tribe of Judas made it just as the Lord commanded Moses,

21 and Eliab the son of Achisamach from the tribe of Dan, who master-built the woven and needleworked and embroidered things, to weave with the scarlet and the linen.

Chapter 38

1 And Beseleel made the ark,

2 and he overlaid it with pure gold inside and outside.

3 And he cast four golden rings for it, two upon the one side and two upon the second side,

4 wide enough for the carrying poles so as to carry it with them.

5 And he made the propitiatory above the ark from gold,

6 and the two golden cherubim,

7 one cherub upon the one end of the propitiatory and one cherub upon the second end of the propitiatory,

8 overshadowing the propitiatory with their wings.

9 And he made the table that is set forth from pure gold;

10 and he cast four rings for it, two upon the one side and two upon the second side, wide enough so as to carry it with the carrying poles in them.

11 And he made the carrying poles of the ark and of the table and overlaid them with gold.

12 And he made the vessels of the table, both the dishes and the censers and the cups and the libation vessels in which he shall pour with them, golden.

13 And he made the lampstand that gives light, golden, with a solid stem,

14 and the branches from both its parts;

15 from its branches the shoots protruding, three from this side and three from that side, equal to one another;

16 and their lamp-cups, which are upon the ends, nut-shaped from them; and the settings from them, so that the lamps may be upon them, and the seventh setting from the end of the lamp-cup upon the summit above, solid, entirely golden;

17 and seven golden lamps upon it and its golden tongs and their golden oil-drawers.

18 This one plated the pillars with silver and cast golden rings for the pillar and overlaid the bars with gold and overlaid the pillars of the veil with gold and made the loops golden.

19 This one also made the rings of the tabernacle golden, and the rings of the court, and bronze rings for stretching the covering above.

20 This one cast the silver capitals of the tabernacle and the bronze capitals of the door of the tabernacle and the gate of the court, and made silver loops for the pillars upon the pillars; this one plated them with silver.

21 This one also made the stakes of the tabernacle and the stakes of the court bronze.

22 This one made the bronze altar from the bronze fire-pans that belonged to the men who rebelled with the congregation of Kore.

23 This one made all the vessels of the altar and its fire-pan and the base and the bowls and the flesh-hooks bronze.

24 This one made for the altar an appendage, a work of network, below the fire-pan under it as far as its middle, and placed upon it four bronze rings from the four parts of the appendage of the altar, wide enough for the bars so as to carry the altar with them.

25 This one made the holy oil of anointing and the compound incense, a pure work of a perfumer.

26 This one made the bronze washing basin and its bronze base from the mirrors of the women who fasted, who fasted beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony on the day when he set it up;

27 and he made the washing basin so that Moses and Aaron and his sons might wash their hands and their feet from it; when they entered into the tabernacle of testimony or whenever they approached the altar to minister, they washed from it, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

Chapter 39

1 All the gold that was worked for the works, according to all the workmanship of the holy things, came to twenty-nine talents and seven hundred twenty shekels of the gold of the firstfruit, according to the holy shekel;

2 and the removal offering of silver from the inspected men of the congregation was one hundred talents and one thousand seven hundred seventy-five shekels,

3 one drachma per head, half of the shekel according to the holy shekel, from everyone passing through the visitation, from twenty years old and above, for six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty.

4 And the one hundred talents of silver were for casting the one hundred capitals of the tabernacle and for the capitals of the veil, one hundred capitals for the one hundred talents, a talent for each capital.

5 And the one thousand seven hundred seventy-five shekels they made into the loops for the pillars, and he overlaid their capitals with gold and adorned them.

6 And the bronze of the removal offering was seventy talents and one thousand five hundred shekels.

7 And he made from it the bases of the door of the tabernacle of testimony,

8 and the bases of the court all around and the bases of the gate of the court and the stakes of the tabernacle and the stakes of the court all around,

9 and the bronze appendage of the altar and all the vessels of the altar and all the implements of the tabernacle of testimony.

10 And the sons of Israel did just as the Lord commanded Moses; thus they did.

11 And the remaining gold of the removal offering they made into vessels for ministering with them before the Lord.

12 And the remaining hyacinth and purple and scarlet they made into ministering vestments for Aaron, so as to minister in them in the holy place.

13 And they brought the vestments to Moses and the tabernacle and its vessels and the bases and its bars and the pillars,

14 and the ark of the covenant and its carrying poles,

15 and the altar and all its vessels and the oil of anointing and the compound incense,

16 and the pure lampstand and its lamps, lamps of burning, and the oil of light,

17 and the table of the presentation and all its vessels and the breads set forth,

18 and the vestments of the holy place that belong to Aaron and the vestments of his sons for the priesthood,

19 and the hangings of the court and the pillars and the veil of the door of the tabernacle and of the gate of the court and all the vessels of the tabernacle and all its implements,

20 and the leathers, the red-dyed ram skins, and the coverings of hyacinth-colored skins and the upper coverings of the remaining things,

21 and the stakes and all the implements for the works of the tabernacle of testimony;

22 all that the Lord commanded Moses, thus the sons of Israel made all the equipment.

23 And Moses saw all the works, and they had made them in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses, thus they made them; and Moses blessed them.

Chapter 40

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 On day one of the first month, at the new moon, you shall erect the tabernacle of testimony,

3 and you shall place the ark of testimony and cover the ark with the veil,

4 and you shall bring in the table and set forth its presentation, and you shall bring in the lampstand and place its lamps,

5 and you shall place the golden altar for burning incense opposite the ark and place a covering of the veil upon the door of the tabernacle of testimony,

6 and you shall place the altar of offerings beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony,

8 and you shall surround the tabernacle and sanctify all its things all around.

9 And you shall take the oil of anointing and anoint the tabernacle and all the things in it and sanctify it and all its vessels, and it shall be holy.

10 And you shall anoint the altar of offerings and all its vessels and sanctify the altar, and the altar shall be Holy of Holies.

12 And you shall bring Aaron and his sons to the doors of the tabernacle of testimony and wash them with water,

13 and you shall clothe Aaron with the holy vestments and anoint him and sanctify him, and he shall serve me as priest;

14 and you shall bring his sons and clothe them with tunics,

15 and you shall anoint them in the manner that you anointed their father, and they shall serve me as priests; and it shall be that an anointing of priesthood is theirs for the age, for their generations.

16 And Moses did all the things that the Lord commanded him; thus he did.

17 And it happened in the first month, in the second year of their going out of Egypt, at the new moon, that the tabernacle was erected;

18 and Moses erected the tabernacle and placed the capitals and inserted the bars through and erected the pillars,

19 and stretched the curtains over the tabernacle and placed the covering of the tabernacle upon it above, just as the Lord commanded Moses. –

20 And taking the testimonies, he put them into the ark and placed the carrying poles beneath the ark,

21 and he brought the ark into the tabernacle and placed the covering of the veil and covered the ark of testimony, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses. –

22 And he placed the table in the tabernacle of testimony upon the side of the tabernacle of testimony toward the north, outside the veil of the tabernacle,

23 and set forth upon it the breads of the presentation before the Lord, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses. –

24 And he placed the lampstand in the tabernacle of testimony, on the side of the tabernacle toward the south,

25 and placed its lamps before the Lord, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses. –

26 And he placed the golden altar in the tabernacle of testimony opposite the veil,

27 and burned the compound incense upon it, just as the Lord commanded Moses. –

29 And he placed the altar of offerings beside the doors of the tabernacle,

33 and erected the court all around the tabernacle and the altar. And Moses completed all the works.

34 And the cloud covered the tabernacle of testimony, and the tabernacle was filled with the glory of the Lord;

35 and Moses was not able to enter into the tabernacle of testimony, because the cloud overshadowed it and the tabernacle was filled with the glory of the Lord.

36 And whenever the cloud rose from the tabernacle, the sons of Israel broke camp with their equipment;

37 but if the cloud did not rise, they did not break camp until the day on which the cloud rose;

38 for a cloud was upon the tabernacle by day, and fire was upon it by night before all Israel in all their departures.

Leviticus

Chapter 1

1 And the Lord called Moses back and spoke to him from the tabernacle of testimony, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: If a man from among you presents gifts to the Lord, from the livestock, from the cattle and from the sheep, you shall present your gifts.

3 If his gift from the cattle is a whole burnt offering, he shall present an unblemished male; he shall bring it to the door of the tabernacle of testimony, acceptable before the Lord.

4 And he shall place his hand upon the head of the offering, acceptable for him to make atonement concerning him.

5 And they shall slaughter the calf before the Lord, and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall bring the blood and pour the blood upon the altar all around, the one at the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

6 And having skinned the whole burnt offering, they shall divide it limb by limb,

7 and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall place fire upon the altar and heap wood upon the fire,

8 and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall heap the divided parts and the head and the fat upon the wood that is upon the fire that is upon the altar,

9 but they shall wash the inward parts and the feet with water, and the priests shall place all the things upon the altar; it is an offering, a sacrifice, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

10 But if his gift to the Lord is from the sheep, from the lambs or from the kids, as a whole burnt offering, he shall present it as an unblemished male and place his hand upon its head.

11 And they shall slaughter it beside the altar toward the north before the Lord, and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall pour its blood upon the altar all around.

12 And they shall divide it limb by limb, and the head and the fat, and the priests shall heap them upon the wood that is upon the fire upon the altar.

13 And they shall wash the inward parts and the feet with water, and the priest shall bring all the things and place them upon the altar; it is an offering, a sacrifice, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

14 But if you offer an offering from the flying creatures as a gift to the Lord, then he shall bring his gift from the turtledoves or from the pigeons.

15 And the priest shall bring it to the altar and pinch off the head, and the priest shall place it upon the altar and drain the blood toward the base of the altar.

16 And he shall remove the crop together with the feathers and cast it beside the altar toward the east, into the place of the ashes.

17 And he shall break it from the wings and shall not divide it, and the priest shall place it upon the altar upon the wood that is upon the fire; it is an offering, a sacrifice, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

Chapter 2

1 But if a soul offers a gift, a sacrifice to the Lord, his gift shall be fine flour, and he shall pour oil upon it and place frankincense upon it; it is a sacrifice.

2 And he shall bring it to the sons of Aaron, the priests, and taking from it a handful full of the fine flour together with the oil and all its frankincense, the priest shall place its memorial upon the altar; a sacrifice, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

3 And the remainder from the sacrifice shall be for Aaron and his sons; Holy of Holies from the sacrifices of the Lord. –

4 But if you offer a gift, a sacrifice baked in an oven, a gift to the Lord from fine flour, it shall be unleavened loaves mixed with oil and unleavened flatcakes anointed throughout with oil. –

5 But if your gift is a sacrifice from a pan, it shall be fine flour mixed with oil, unleavened;

6 and you shall break them into pieces and pour oil upon them; it is a sacrifice to the Lord. –

7 But if your gift is a sacrifice from a grate, fine flour shall be made with oil.

8 And he shall bring the sacrifice that he makes from these things to the Lord; and he shall bring it to the priest, and approaching the altar,

9 the priest shall remove its memorial from the sacrifice, and the priest shall place it upon the altar; an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

10 But the thing remaining from the sacrifice shall be for Aaron and his sons; Holy of Holies from the offerings of the Lord.

11 Every sacrifice that you offer to the Lord you shall not make leavened; for you shall not bring any leaven or any honey from it to offer to the Lord.

12 As a gift of firstfruit you shall bring them to the Lord, but it shall not be brought up upon the altar as an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

13 And every gift of your sacrifice shall be salted with salt; you shall not cease the salt of the covenant of the Lord from your sacrifices; upon every gift of yours you shall bring salt to the Lord your God. –

14 But if you offer a sacrifice of first produce to the Lord, new roasted groats, pounded, to the Lord, then you shall bring the sacrifice of the first produce,

15 and you shall pour oil upon it and place frankincense upon it; it is a sacrifice.

16 And the priest shall offer its memorial from the groats together with the oil and all its frankincense; it is an offering to the Lord.

Chapter 3

1 But if his gift to the Lord is a sacrifice of salvation, if he presents it from his cattle, whether male or female, he shall present it unblemished before the Lord.

2 And he shall place his hands upon the head of the gift and slaughter it beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony, and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall pour the blood upon the altar of whole burnt offerings all around.

3 And they shall present from the sacrifice of salvation an offering to the Lord: the fat covering the belly and all the fat upon the belly,

4 and the two kidneys and the fat upon them that is upon the thighs and the lobe upon the liver [together with the kidneys he shall remove it],

5 and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall offer them upon the altar, upon the whole burnt offerings, upon the wood that is upon the fire upon the altar; an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

6 But if his gift is from the sheep, a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord, he shall bring it, male or female, unblemished.

7 If he presents a lamb as his gift, he shall present it before the Lord,

8 and he shall place his hands upon the head of his gift and slaughter it beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony, and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall pour the blood upon the altar all around.

9 And he shall bring from the sacrifice of salvation an offering to God: the fat and the unblemished loin [together with the loin muscles he shall remove it] and the fat of the belly,

10 and both kidneys and the fat upon them that is upon the thighs and the lobe upon the liver [removing it together with the kidneys],

11 the priest shall offer it upon the altar; an odor of sweetness, an offering to the Lord.

12 But if his gift is from the goats, then he shall present it before the Lord,

13 and he shall place his hands upon its head, and they shall slaughter it before the Lord beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony, and the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall pour the blood upon the altar all around.

14 And he shall offer from it an offering to the Lord: the fat covering the belly and all the fat upon the belly,

15 and both kidneys and all the fat upon them that is upon the thighs and the lobe of the liver [together with the kidneys he shall remove it],

16 and the priest shall offer it upon the altar; an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord. All the fat belongs to the Lord;

17 an ordinance for the age for your generations in every dwelling of yours: you shall not eat any fat or any blood.

Chapter 4

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: If a soul sins involuntarily before the Lord from the ordinances of the Lord that ought not to be done, and does any one of them;

3 if the anointed high priest sins so that the people sin, then for his sin that he sinned he shall present an unblemished calf from the cattle to the Lord for his sin.

4 And he shall present the calf beside the door of the tabernacle of testimony before the Lord and place his hand upon the head of the calf before the Lord and slaughter the calf before the Lord.

5 And the anointed priest whose hands have been perfected, taking from the blood of the calf, shall bring it into the tabernacle of testimony;

6 and the priest shall dip his finger into the blood and sprinkle from the blood seven times before the Lord, along the holy veil;

7 and the priest shall place some of the blood of the calf upon the horns of the altar of compound incense before the Lord, which is in the tabernacle of testimony; and all the blood of the calf he shall pour out beside the base of the altar of whole burnt offerings, which is beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

8 And he shall remove from it all the fat of the calf of sin: the fat covering the inward parts and all the fat upon the inward parts,

9 and the two kidneys and the fat upon them that is upon the thighs and the lobe upon the liver [together with the kidneys he shall remove it],

10 in the manner that it is removed from the calf of the sacrifice of salvation, and the priest shall offer it upon the altar of offering.

11 And the skin of the calf and all its flesh together with the head and the extremities and the belly and the dung,

12 and they shall carry the whole calf outside the camp into a clean place, where they pour out the ashes, and burn it upon wood with fire; it shall be burned upon the outpouring of the ashes.

13 But if the whole congregation of Israel is involuntarily ignorant and a matter escapes the eyes of the congregation, and they do one of all the commandments of the Lord that shall not be done, and they trespass,

14 and the sin in which they sinned becomes known to them, then the congregation shall present an unblemished calf from the cattle for the sin and present it beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

15 And the elders of the congregation shall place their hands upon the head of the calf before the Lord and shall slaughter the calf before the Lord.

16 And the anointed priest shall bring some of the blood of the calf into the tabernacle of testimony;

17 and the priest shall dip his finger into some of the blood of the calf and sprinkle seven times before the Lord, directly before the veil of the holy place;

18 and the priest shall place some of the blood upon the horns of the altar of compound incense offerings that is before the Lord, which is in the tabernacle of testimony; and all the blood he shall pour toward the base of the altar of offerings that is beside the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

19 And he shall remove all the fat from it and offer it upon the altar;

20 and he shall do with the calf in the manner that he did with the calf of sin, thus it shall be done; and the priest shall make atonement concerning them, and the sin shall be forgiven them.

21 And they shall carry the whole calf outside the camp and burn the calf in the manner that they burned the former calf. It is the sin of the congregation.

22 But if the ruler sins and involuntarily does one of all the commandments of the Lord their God that shall not be done, and sins and trespasses,

23 and the sin in which he sinned becomes known to him, then he shall bring his gift, a male kid from the goats, unblemished.

24 And he shall place his hand upon the head of the kid, and they shall slaughter it in the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offerings before the Lord; it is sin.

25 And the priest shall place some of the blood of the thing of sin with his finger upon the horns of the altar of whole burnt offerings; and all its blood he shall pour out beside the base of the altar of whole burnt offerings.

26 And he shall offer all its fat upon the altar, like the fat of a sacrifice of salvation. And the priest shall make atonement concerning him from his sin, and it shall be forgiven him.

27 But if one soul from the people of the land sins involuntarily by doing one of all the commandments of the Lord that shall not be done, and trespasses,

28 and the sin in which he sinned becomes known to him, then he shall bring a female kid from the goats, unblemished; he shall bring it for the sin that he sinned.

29 And he shall place his hand upon the head of his sin, and they shall slaughter the she-goat of sin in the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offerings.

30 And the priest shall take some of its blood with his finger and place it upon the horns of the altar of whole burnt offerings; and all its blood he shall pour out beside the base of the altar.

31 And he shall remove all the fat in the manner that fat is removed from a sacrifice of salvation, and the priest shall offer it upon the altar for an odor of sweetness to the Lord. And the priest shall make atonement concerning him, and it shall be forgiven him. –

32 But if he presents a sheep as his gift for sin, he shall bring it as an unblemished female.

33 And he shall place his hand upon the head of the thing of sin, and they shall slaughter it in the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offerings.

34 And the priest, taking some of the blood of the thing of sin with his finger, shall place it upon the horns of the altar of whole burnt offering; and all its blood he shall pour out beside the base of the altar of whole burnt offering.

35 And he shall remove all its fat in the manner that the fat of a sheep is removed from the sacrifice of salvation, and the priest shall place it upon the altar, upon the whole burnt offering of the Lord. And the priest shall make atonement concerning him for the sin that he sinned, and it shall be forgiven him.

Chapter 5

1 But if a soul sins and hears the voice of an oath, and he is a witness [either he saw or knows], if he does not report it, he shall bear the sin;

2 or a soul that touches any unclean thing, whether an unclean carcass or an unclean thing caught by a beast or any of the carcasses or any of the unclean abominations or any of the carcasses of unclean livestock,

3 or touches any human uncleanness, any of his uncleanness by which, having touched it, he is defiled, and it escapes him, but after this he knows and trespasses,

4 or a soul that swears, defining with the lips to do evil or to do good according to anything a man defines with an oath, and it escapes him before his eyes, and he knows and sins in any one of these,

5 then he shall declare openly the sin concerning the things in which he sinned against it,

6 and for the things in which he trespassed he shall bring to the Lord, for the sin that he sinned, a female from the sheep, a ewe lamb or a she-goat from the goats, for sin; and the priest shall make atonement concerning him for his sin that he sinned, and the sin shall be forgiven him.

7 But if his hand is not strong enough for what is sufficient for a sheep, he shall bring for his sin that he sinned two turtledoves or two young pigeons to the Lord, one for sin and one as a whole burnt offering.

8 And he shall bring them to the priest, and the priest shall present the one for sin first; and the priest shall pinch off its head from the neck and shall not divide it;

9 and he shall sprinkle some of the blood of the thing for sin upon the wall of the altar, but the remainder of the blood he shall drain down upon the base of the altar; for it is of sin.

10 And he shall make the second a whole burnt offering, as is fitting. And the priest shall make atonement concerning his sin that he sinned, and it shall be forgiven him. –

11 But if his hand does not find a pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons, then he shall bring his gift for that in which he sinned, a tenth of an oiphi of fine flour for sin; he shall not pour oil upon it or place frankincense upon it, because it is for sin;

12 and he shall bring it to the priest. And the priest, taking from it a handful full, shall place its memorial upon the altar of whole burnt offerings to the Lord; it is sin.

13 And the priest shall make atonement concerning him for his sin that he sinned in any one of these, and it shall be forgiven him. But the thing remaining shall be for the priest, like the sacrifice of fine flour.

14 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

15 If forgetfulness escapes a soul and he sins involuntarily from the holy things of the Lord, then for his trespass he shall bring to the Lord an unblemished ram from the sheep, of a value in silver shekels according to the shekel of the holy things, for that in which he trespassed.

16 And that in which he sinned from the holy things, he shall repay it and add the fifth part upon it and give it to the priest; and the priest shall make atonement concerning him with the ram of trespass, and it shall be forgiven him.

17 And the soul that sins and does one of all the commandments of the Lord that ought not to be done, and did not know, and trespasses and bears the sin,

18 shall bring an unblemished ram from the sheep, of a value in silver, for trespass, to the priest; and the priest shall make atonement concerning him for his ignorance in which he was ignorant and he himself did not know, and it shall be forgiven him;

19 for he trespassed a trespass before the Lord.

20 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

21 If a soul sins and, overlooking, overlooks the commandments of the Lord, and lies in matters concerning his neighbor, concerning a deposit or concerning partnership or concerning robbery, or wrongs his neighbor in anything,

22 or finds a lost thing and lies concerning it and swears unjustly concerning any one of all the things a man may do so as to sin in these,

23 then it shall be, whenever he sins and trespasses, that he shall return the thing stolen that he stole, or the wrong by which he wronged, or the deposit that was entrusted to him, or the lost thing that he found,

24 from every matter concerning which he swore unjustly, and he shall repay the principal and add the fifth part upon it; to whomever it belongs, to him he shall return it on the day when he is convicted.

25 And for his trespass he shall bring to the Lord an unblemished ram from the sheep, of a value for that in which he trespassed against him.

26 And the priest shall make atonement concerning him before the Lord, and it shall be forgiven him concerning any one of all the things that he did and trespassed against him.

Chapter 6

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Command Aaron and his sons, saying: This is the law of the whole burnt offering. This whole burnt offering shall be upon its burning upon the altar the whole night until morning, and the fire of the altar shall burn upon it; it shall not be extinguished.

3 And the priest shall put on a linen tunic and shall put linen breeches around his body and shall remove the consumed offering that the fire consumes from the whole burnt offering from the altar and place it beside the altar.

4 And he shall take off his vestment and put on another vestment and carry the consumed offering outside the camp into a clean place.

5 And fire shall burn upon the altar from it and shall not be extinguished, and the priest shall burn wood upon it in the morning and heap the whole burnt offering upon it and place upon it the fat of the salvation offering;

6 and fire shall burn continually upon the altar; it shall not be extinguished.

7 This is the law of the sacrifice that the sons of Aaron shall present before the Lord opposite the altar;

8 and he shall remove from it with a handful some of the fine flour of the sacrifice, together with its oil and together with its frankincense that are upon the sacrifice, and shall offer it upon the altar as an offering; an odor of sweetness, its memorial to the Lord.

9 But Aaron and his sons shall eat the thing remaining from it; it shall be eaten unleavened in a holy place; in the court of the tabernacle of testimony they shall eat it.

10 It shall not be baked leavened; I have given it to them as a portion from the offerings of the Lord; Holy of Holies, like the thing of sin and like the thing of trespass.

11 Every male of the priests shall eat it; an eternal ordinance for your generations from the offerings of the Lord. Everyone who touches them shall be sanctified.

12 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

13 This is the gift of Aaron and his sons that they shall bring to the Lord on the day when you anoint him: a tenth of an oiphi of fine flour as a sacrifice continually, half of it in the morning and half of it in the evening.

14 It shall be made upon a pan with oil; mixed, you shall bring it, rolled, a sacrifice from pieces, a sacrifice as an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

15 The anointed priest in his place from among his sons shall make it; an eternal law, the whole shall be fully offered.

16 And every sacrifice of a priest shall be entirely burned and shall not be eaten.

17 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

18 Speak to Aaron and his sons, saying: This is the law of sin. In the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offering, they shall slaughter the things for sin before the Lord; it is Holy of Holies.

19 The priest who offers it shall eat it; it shall be eaten in a holy place, in the court of the tabernacle of testimony.

20 Everyone who touches its flesh shall be sanctified; and whatever garment is sprinkled from its blood, the thing sprinkled upon it shall be washed in a holy place.

21 And an earthen vessel in which it is boiled shall be shattered; but if it is boiled in a bronze vessel, he shall scour it out and rinse it with water.

22 Every male among the priests shall eat them; it is Holy of Holies of the Lord.

23 And none of the things for sin, from whose blood any is brought into the tabernacle of testimony to make atonement in the holy place, shall be eaten; it shall be burned with fire.

Chapter 7

1 And this is the law of the ram for trespass; it is Holy of Holies.

2 In the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offering, they shall slaughter the ram of trespass before the Lord, and he shall pour the blood upon the base of the altar all around.

3 And he shall bring from it all its fat, and the loin and all the fat covering the inward parts and all the fat upon the inward parts,

4 and the two kidneys and the fat upon them that is upon the thighs and the lobe upon the liver [together with the kidneys he shall remove them],

5 and the priest shall offer them upon the altar as an offering to the Lord; it is for trespass.

6 Every male from the priests shall eat them; in a holy place they shall eat them; it is Holy of Holies.

7 As the thing for sin, so also the thing of trespass; there is one law for them; it shall belong to the priest who makes atonement with it.

8 And the priest who presents a man’s whole burnt offering, the skin of the whole burnt offering that he himself offers shall belong to him.

9 And every sacrifice that is made in the oven, and every one that is made upon a grate or upon a pan, shall belong to the priest who offers it.

10 And every sacrifice mixed with oil and not mixed shall belong to all the sons of Aaron, an equal share to each.

11 This is the law of a sacrifice of salvation that they shall bring to the Lord.

12 If he offers it for praise, then upon the sacrifice of praise he shall bring loaves from fine flour mixed with oil, unleavened flatcakes anointed throughout with oil, and fine flour mixed with oil;

13 with leavened loaves he shall bring his gifts upon a sacrifice of praise of salvation.

14 And he shall present one from all his gifts as a removal offering to the Lord; it shall belong to the priest who pours the blood of the salvation offering.

15 And the flesh of a sacrifice of praise of salvation shall belong to him, and it shall be eaten on the day on which it is given; they shall not leave any of it until morning.

16 And if he sacrifices his gift as a vow or a voluntary gift, it shall be eaten on the day on which he presents his sacrifice and on the morrow;

17 and the thing remaining from the flesh of the sacrifice until the third day shall be burned with fire.

18 But if, eating, he eats from the flesh on the third day, it shall not be accepted for the one who offers it, it shall not be reckoned to him; it is a defilement; and the soul that eats from it shall bear the sin.

19 And any flesh that touches anything unclean shall not be eaten; it shall be burned with fire. Everyone clean shall eat flesh.

20 But the soul that eats from the flesh of the sacrifice of salvation that belongs to the Lord while his uncleanness is upon him, that soul shall perish from his people.

21 And a soul that touches any unclean thing, whether from human uncleanness or from unclean quadrupeds or from any unclean abomination, and eats from the flesh of the sacrifice of salvation that belongs to the Lord, that soul shall perish from his people.

22 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

23 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: You shall not eat any fat of cattle and sheep and goats.

24 And fat from carcasses and from what is caught by a beast may be used for any work, but it shall not be eaten as food.

25 Everyone who eats fat from the livestock from which he brings an offering to the Lord, that soul shall perish from his people.

26 You shall not eat any blood in any of your dwellings, whether from flying creatures or from livestock.

27 Every soul that eats blood, that soul shall perish from his people.

28 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

29 And you shall speak to the sons of Israel, saying: The one who offers a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord shall bring his gift to the Lord from the sacrifice of salvation.

30 His hands shall bring the offerings to the Lord; the fat upon the breast and the lobe of the liver, he shall bring them so as to place a gift before the Lord.

31 And the priest shall offer the fat upon the altar, and the breast shall belong to Aaron and his sons.

32 And you shall give the right arm as a removal offering to the priest from your sacrifices of salvation;

33 the one from the sons of Aaron who offers the blood of the salvation offering and the fat, the right arm shall be a portion for him.

34 For I have taken the breast of the placement and the arm of the removal offering from the sons of Israel, from your sacrifices of salvation, and have given them to Aaron the priest and his sons as an eternal ordinance from the sons of Israel.

35 This is the anointing of Aaron and the anointing of his sons from the offerings of the Lord on the day when he brought them near to serve the Lord as priests,

36 just as the Lord commanded to give them on the day when he anointed them, from the sons of Israel; an eternal ordinance for their generations.

37 This is the law of the whole burnt offerings and sacrifice and the thing for sin and the thing of trespass and the perfection and the sacrifice of salvation,

38 in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses on Mount Sina on the day when he commanded the sons of Israel to bring their gifts before the Lord in the wilderness of Sina.

Chapter 8

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Take Aaron and his sons and his vestments and the oil of anointing and the calf for sin and the two rams and the basket of unleavened things,

3 and assemble the whole congregation at the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

4 And Moses did in the manner that the Lord commanded him, and he assembled the congregation at the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

5 And Moses said to the congregation: This is the word that the Lord commanded to be done.

6 And Moses brought Aaron and his sons near and washed them with water;

7 and he clothed him with the tunic and girded him with the sash and clothed him with the undergarment and placed the shoulder piece upon him and bound him according to the workmanship of the shoulder piece and fastened him with it;

8 and he placed the oracle upon it and placed the Manifestation and the Truth upon the oracle;

9 and he placed the miter upon his head and placed upon the miter, toward his face, the golden plate, the sanctified holy thing, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses.

10 And Moses took from the oil of anointing,

11 and sprinkled some of it upon the altar seven times and anointed the altar and sanctified it and all its vessels and the washing basin and its base and sanctified them; and he anointed the tabernacle and all the things in it and sanctified it.

12 And Moses poured some of the oil of anointing upon the head of Aaron and anointed him and sanctified him.

13 And Moses brought the sons of Aaron near and clothed them with tunics and girded them with sashes and placed turbans around them, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

14 And Moses brought the calf for sin near, and Aaron and his sons placed their hands upon the head of the calf of sin.

15 And he slaughtered it, and Moses took some of the blood and placed it upon the horns of the altar all around with his finger and cleansed the altar; and he poured the blood upon the base of the altar and sanctified it, to make atonement upon it.

16 And Moses took all the fat upon the inward parts and the lobe upon the liver and both kidneys and the fat upon them, and Moses offered them upon the altar;

17 and the calf and its hide and its flesh and its dung, and he burned them with fire outside the camp, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses.

18 And Moses brought near the ram for a whole burnt offering, and Aaron and his sons placed their hands upon the head of the ram.

19 And Moses slaughtered the ram, and Moses poured the blood upon the altar all around.

20 And he cut the ram into flesh limb by limb, and Moses offered the head and the limbs and the fat;

21 and he washed the belly and the feet with water, and Moses offered the whole ram upon the altar; a whole burnt offering, which is for an odor of sweetness, it is an offering to the Lord, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

22 And Moses brought the second ram near, a ram of perfection; and Aaron and his sons placed their hands upon the head of the ram.

23 And he slaughtered it, and Moses took some of its blood and placed it upon the lobe of Aaron’s right ear and upon the tip of his right hand and upon the tip of his right foot.

24 And Moses brought the sons of Aaron near, and Moses placed some of the blood upon the lobes of their right ears and upon the tips of their right hands and upon the tips of their right feet, and Moses poured the blood upon the altar all around.

25 And he took the fat and the loin and the fat upon the belly and the lobe of the liver and the two kidneys and the fat upon them and the right arm;

26 and from the basket of perfection that was before the Lord he took one unleavened loaf and one loaf made with oil and one flatcake and placed them upon the fat and the right arm;

27 and he placed all the things upon the hands of Aaron and upon the hands of his sons and offered them as a removal offering before the Lord.

28 And Moses took them from their hands, and Moses offered them upon the altar, upon the whole burnt offering of perfection, which is an odor of sweetness; it is an offering to the Lord.

29 And Moses, taking the breast, removed it as a placement before the Lord from the ram of perfection, and it became a portion for Moses, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

30 And Moses took some of the oil of anointing and some of the blood upon the altar and sprinkled it upon Aaron and his vestments and his sons and the vestments of his sons with him and sanctified Aaron and his vestments and his sons and the vestments of his sons with him.

31 And Moses said to Aaron and his sons: Boil the flesh in the court of the tabernacle of testimony, in a holy place, and there you shall eat it and the loaves in the basket of perfection, in the manner that it has been commanded to me, saying: Aaron and his sons shall eat them;

32 and the thing remaining from the flesh and the loaves shall be burned with fire.

33 And you shall not go out from the door of the tabernacle of testimony for seven days, until the day is fulfilled, the day of your perfection; for he shall perfect your hands for seven days.

34 Just as he did on this day, the Lord commanded it to be done so as to make atonement concerning you.

35 And you shall sit at the door of the tabernacle of testimony for seven days, day and night; you shall keep the guardings of the Lord, so that you do not die; for thus the Lord God commanded me.

36 And Aaron and his sons did all the words that the Lord commanded Moses.

Chapter 9

1 And it happened on the eighth day that Moses called Aaron and his sons and the council of elders of Israel.

2 And Moses said to Aaron: Take for yourself a calf from the cattle for sin and an unblemished ram as a whole burnt offering, and offer them before the Lord;

3 and speak to the council of elders of Israel, saying: Take one male kid from the goats for sin and a calf and a year-old lamb for a whole offering, unblemished,

4 and a calf and a ram as a sacrifice of salvation before the Lord and fine flour mixed with oil, because today the Lord shall appear among you.

5 And they took the things, as Moses commanded, opposite the tabernacle of testimony, and the whole congregation approached and stood before the Lord.

6 And Moses said: Do this word that the Lord spoke, and the glory of the Lord shall appear among you.

7 And Moses said to Aaron: Approach the altar and make the thing for your sin and your whole burnt offering and make atonement concerning yourself and your house; and make the gifts of the people and make atonement concerning them, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

8 And Aaron approached the altar and slaughtered the calf for sin;

9 and the sons of Aaron brought the blood to him, and he dipped his finger into the blood and placed it upon the horns of the altar and poured the blood upon the base of the altar;

10 and the fat and the kidneys and the lobe of the liver of the thing for sin he offered upon the altar, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses;

11 and the flesh and the hide, he burned them with fire outside the camp.

12 And he slaughtered the whole burnt offering; and the sons of Aaron brought the blood to him, and he poured it upon the altar all around;

13 and they brought the whole burnt offering to him limb by limb, them and the head, and he placed them upon the altar;

14 and he washed the belly and the feet with water and placed them upon the whole burnt offering upon the altar.

15 And they brought the gift of the people; and he took the male kid for the sin of the people and slaughtered it just as also the first.

16 And he brought the whole burnt offering and made it as is fitting.

17 And he brought the sacrifice and filled his hands from it and placed it upon the altar apart from the morning whole burnt offering.

18 And he slaughtered the calf and the ram of the sacrifice of salvation of the people; and the sons of Aaron brought the blood to him, and he poured it toward the altar all around;

19 and the fat from the calf and the ram, the loin and the fat covering upon the belly and the two kidneys and the fat upon them and the lobe upon the liver,

20 and he placed the fats upon the breasts, and they offered the fats upon the altar.

21 And Aaron removed the breast and the right arm as a removal offering before the Lord, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses. –

22 And Aaron, lifting his hands over the people, blessed them; and he came down after making the thing for sin and the whole burnt offerings and the things of salvation.

23 And Moses and Aaron entered into the tabernacle of testimony and, going out, blessed all the people, and the glory of the Lord appeared to all the people.

24 And fire came out from the Lord and consumed the things upon the altar, both the whole burnt offerings and the fats, and all the people saw and were astonished and fell upon their face.

Chapter 10

1 And the two sons of Aaron, Nadab and Abioud, each taking his fire-pan, placed fire upon it and put incense upon it and brought strange fire before the Lord, which the Lord had not commanded them.

2 And fire came out from the Lord and consumed them, and they died before the Lord.

3 And Moses said to Aaron: This is what the Lord spoke, saying: Among those who draw near to me I will be sanctified, and in the whole congregation I will be glorified. And Aaron was pierced with grief.

4 And Moses called Misadai and Elisaphan, sons of Oziel, sons of the brother of Aaron’s father, and said to them: Approach and carry your brothers away from the face of the holy things, outside the camp.

5 And they approached and carried them in their tunics outside the camp, in the manner that Moses said.

6 And Moses said to Aaron and Eleazar and Ithamar, his sons who remained: You shall not remove the turbans from your heads, and you shall not tear your garments, so that you do not die and there is wrath upon the whole congregation; your brothers, the whole house of Israel, shall weep for the burning with which they were burned by the Lord.

7 And you shall not go out from the door of the tabernacle of testimony, so that you do not die; for the oil of anointing from the Lord is upon you. And they did according to the word of Moses.

8 And the Lord spoke to Aaron, saying:

9 You shall not drink wine or sikera, you and your sons with you, whenever you enter into the tabernacle of testimony or when you approach the altar, and you shall certainly not die [an eternal ordinance for your generations],

10 to distinguish between the holy things and the profane things and between the unclean things and the clean things.

11 And you shall instruct the sons of Israel in all the ordinances that the Lord spoke to them by the hand of Moses.

12 And Moses said to Aaron and to Eleazar and Ithamar, the sons of Aaron who remained: Take the sacrifice remaining from the offerings of the Lord and eat it unleavened beside the altar; it is Holy of Holies.

13 And you shall eat it in a holy place; for this is an ordinance for you and an ordinance for your sons from the offerings of the Lord; for thus it has been commanded to me.

14 And you and your sons and your household with you shall eat the breast of separation and the arm of the removal offering in a holy place; for it was given as an ordinance for you and an ordinance for your sons from the sacrifices of salvation of the sons of Israel.

15 They shall bring the arm of the removal offering and the breast of separation upon the offerings of the fats, to separate them as a separation before the Lord; and it shall be an eternal ordinance for you and your sons and your daughters with you, in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses.

16 And seeking, Moses sought out the male kid for sin, and behold, it had been burned; and Moses was angered against Eleazar and Ithamar, the sons of Aaron who remained, saying:

17 Why did you not eat the thing for sin in a holy place? For it is Holy of Holies; he gave this to you to eat so that you may take away the sin of the congregation and make atonement concerning them before the Lord;

18 for none of its blood was brought into the holy place; toward the front, inside, you shall eat it in a holy place, in the manner that the Lord commanded me.

19 And Aaron spoke to Moses, saying: If today they have brought the things for their sin and their whole burnt offerings before the Lord, and these things have happened to me, and I eat the things for sin today, will it be pleasing to the Lord?

20 And Moses heard, and it pleased him.

Chapter 11

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: These are the animals that you shall eat from all the animals that are upon the earth:

3 every animal that divides the hoof and splits the claws into two divisions of the hoof and brings up cud among the animals, these you shall eat.

4 Except from these you shall not eat: from those that bring up cud and from those that divide the hooves and split the claws: the camel, because it brings up cud, but does not divide the hoof; this is unclean for you;

5 and the hare, because it brings up cud but does not divide the hoof; this is unclean for you;

6 and the hyrax, because it brings up cud but does not divide the hoof; this is unclean for you;

7 and the pig, because it divides the hoof and splits the claws of the hoof, but it does not bring up cud; this is unclean for you.

8 You shall not eat from their flesh, and you shall not touch their carcasses; these are unclean for you.

9 And these are what you shall eat from all the things in the waters: all those that have fins and scales in the waters and in the seas and in the torrents, these you shall eat.

10 And all those that do not have fins or scales in the water or in the seas and in the torrents, from all that the waters belch forth and from every living soul that is in the water, are an abomination;

11 and they shall be abominations for you; you shall not eat from their flesh, and you shall abominate their carcasses.

12 And all those that do not have fins and scales, among the things in the water, this is an abomination for you.

13 And these you shall abominate from among the birds, and they shall not be eaten; they are an abomination: the eagle and the griffon-vulture and the sea eagle,

14 and the vulture and the kite and those like it,

15 and the raven and those like it,

16 and the ostrich and the owl and the gull and those like it and the hawk and those like it,

17 and the night raven and the cormorant and the ibis,

18 and the purple swamphen and the pelican and the swan,

19 and the owl and the heron and the plover and those like it and the hoopoe and the bat. –

20 And all the creeping things among the birds that go upon four are abominations for you.

21 But these you shall eat from among the creeping things of the birds that go upon four: those that have legs above their feet, to leap with them upon the earth.

22 And these you shall eat from among them: the bruchus and those like it and the attakes and those like it and the locust and those like it and the serpent-fighter and those like it.

23 Every creeping thing from among the birds that has four feet is an abomination for you. –

24 And by these you shall be defiled; everyone who touches their carcasses shall be unclean until evening,

25 and everyone who carries any of their carcasses shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening.

26 Among all the animals, whatever divides the hoof and splits the claws but does not chew cud shall be unclean for you; everyone who touches their carcasses shall be unclean until evening.

27 And every one that goes upon its hands among all the wild animals that go upon four shall be unclean for you; everyone who touches their carcasses shall be unclean until evening.

28 And the one who carries their carcasses shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening; these are unclean for you.

29 And these are unclean for you from among the creeping things that creep upon the earth: the weasel and the mouse and the land crocodile,

30 the shrew and the chameleon and the kalabotes and the lizard and the mole.

31 These are unclean for you from among all the creeping things that are upon the earth; everyone who touches them when they are dead shall be unclean until evening.

32 And everything upon which any of them falls when they are dead shall be unclean, whether any wooden vessel or garment or hide or sack; every vessel by which work is done shall be dipped into water and shall be unclean until evening, and then it shall be clean.

33 And every earthen vessel into which any of these falls inside, whatever is inside shall be unclean, and it shall be broken.

34 And every food that is eaten, upon which water comes, shall be unclean; and every drink that is drunk in any vessel shall be unclean.

35 And everything upon which any of their carcasses falls shall be unclean; ovens and pot-stands shall be pulled down; these are unclean and these shall be unclean for you.

36 Except for springs of waters and a cistern and a gathering of water, it shall be clean; but the one who touches their carcasses shall be unclean.

37 And if any of their carcasses falls upon any seed for sowing that shall be sown, it shall be clean;

38 but if water is poured upon any seed and any of their carcasses falls upon it, it is unclean for you.

39 And if one of the animals that is permitted for you to eat dies, the one who touches its carcass shall be unclean until evening.

40 And the one who eats from these carcasses shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening; and the one who carries any of their carcasses shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

41 And every creeping thing that creeps upon the earth, this shall be an abomination for you; it shall not be eaten.

42 And every one that goes upon its belly and every one that goes continually upon four, which multiplies in feet among all the creeping things that creep upon the earth, you shall not eat it, because it is an abomination for you.

43 And you shall certainly not make your souls abominable by any of the creeping things that creep upon the earth, and you shall not be defiled by these, and you shall not be unclean by them;

44 because I am the Lord your God, and you shall be sanctified and shall be holy, because I am holy, I the Lord your God; and you shall not defile your souls by any of the creeping things that move upon the earth;

45 because I am the Lord who brought you up from the land of Egypt to be your God, and you shall be holy, because I am holy, I the Lord.

46 This is the law concerning the animals and the birds and every soul that moves in the water and every soul that creeps upon the earth,

47 to distinguish between the unclean and the clean and between the live-bearing creatures that are eaten and the live-bearing creatures that are not eaten.

Chapter 12

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: A woman, if she receives seed and bears a male, shall be unclean seven days; according to the days of the separation of her menstruation she shall be unclean.

3 And on the eighth day he shall circumcise the flesh of his foreskin.

4 And she shall remain thirty-three days in her unclean blood; she shall not touch any holy thing and shall not enter into the sanctuary until the days of her cleansing are fulfilled.

5 But if she bears a female, she shall be unclean twice seven days, according to the menstruation; and sixty-six days she shall remain in her unclean blood.

6 And when the days of her cleansing for a son or for a daughter are completed, she shall offer a year-old unblemished lamb as a whole burnt offering and a young pigeon or a turtledove concerning sin at the door of the tabernacle of testimony to the priest;

7 and he shall offer it before the Lord, and the priest shall make atonement concerning her and cleanse her from the fountain of her blood. This is the law of the one who bears a male or a female.

8 But if her hand does not find what is sufficient for a lamb, then she shall take two turtledoves or two young pigeons, one as a whole burnt offering and one concerning sin, and the priest shall make atonement concerning her, and she shall be cleansed.

Chapter 13

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 If there arises in the skin of the body of any person a scar, a conspicuously bright mark, and there arises in the skin of his body a leprous lesion, then he shall be brought to Aaron the priest or to one of his sons the priests.

3 And the priest shall see the lesion in the skin of his body, and if the hair in the lesion has changed white and the appearance of the lesion is lower than the skin of the body, it is a leprous lesion; and the priest shall see it and shall defile him.

4 But if there is a white bright mark in the skin of the body, and its appearance is not lower than the skin, and its hair has not changed to white hair, but it is dim, then the priest shall set the lesion apart seven days.

5 And the priest shall see the lesion on the seventh day, and behold, the lesion remains before him; the lesion has not advanced in the skin, and the priest shall set him apart seven days a second time.

6 And the priest shall see him on the seventh day a second time, and behold, the lesion is dim; the lesion has not advanced in the skin; the priest shall cleanse him, for it is a mark; and when he has washed his garments, he shall be clean.

7 But if the mark, changing, advances in the skin after he has seen the priest for him to cleanse him, then he shall appear to the priest a second time;

8 and the priest shall see him, and behold, the mark has advanced in the skin, and the priest shall defile him; it is leprosy.

9 And if a leprous lesion arises in a person, then he shall come to the priest;

10 and the priest shall see, and behold, a white scar is in the skin, and it has changed hair white, and some of the sound living flesh is in the scar;

11 it is an old-growing leprosy; it is in the skin of his body, and the priest shall defile him and set him apart, because he is unclean.

12 But if, blossoming, the leprosy blossoms in the skin, and the leprosy covers all the skin of the lesion from head to feet, throughout the whole sight of the priest,

13 then the priest shall see, and behold, the leprosy has covered all the skin of the body, and the priest shall cleanse him of the lesion, because all of it has changed white; it is clean.

14 And on whatever day living skin appears in him, he shall be defiled;

15 and the priest shall see the sound skin, and the sound skin shall defile him, because he is unclean; it is leprosy.

16 But if the sound skin is restored and changes white, then he shall come to the priest;

17 and the priest shall see, and behold, the lesion has changed to white, and the priest shall cleanse the lesion; he is clean.

18 And if an ulcer arises in the skin of his flesh and heals,

19 and there arises in the place of the ulcer a white scar or a bright spot whitening or reddening, then it shall appear to the priest;

20 and the priest shall see, and behold, its appearance is lower than the skin and its hair has changed to white, and the priest shall defile him; it is leprosy; it has blossomed in the ulcer.

21 But if the priest sees, and behold, there is no white hair in it, and it is not lower than the skin of the body, and it is dim, then the priest shall set him apart seven days.

22 But if it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall defile him; it is a leprous lesion; it has blossomed in the ulcer.

23 But if the bright spot remains in its place and does not spread, it is the scar of the ulcer, and the priest shall cleanse him.

24 And if there arises in the skin of his flesh a burn of fire, and the healed part of the burn in his skin becomes a shining bright white spot tending red or very white,

25 then the priest shall see him, and behold, white hair has changed in the shining spot and its appearance is lower than the skin; it is leprosy; it has blossomed in the burn, and the priest shall defile him; it is a leprous lesion.

26 But if the priest sees, and behold, there is no white hair in the shining spot, and it is not lower than the skin, but it is dim, then the priest shall set him apart seven days.

27 And the priest shall see him on the seventh day; but if, with spreading, it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall defile him; it is a leprous lesion; it has blossomed in the ulcer.

28 But if the shining spot remains in its place and does not spread in the skin, and it is dim, it is the scar of the burn, and the priest shall cleanse him, for it is the mark of the burn.

29 And if there arises in a man or a woman a leprous lesion on the head or on the beard,

30 then the priest shall see the lesion, and behold, its appearance is more hollow than the skin and there is thin yellowish hair in it, and the priest shall defile him; it is a scall, a leprosy of the head or a leprosy of the beard.

31 And if the priest sees the lesion of the scall, and behold, its appearance is not more hollow than the skin and there is no yellowish hair in it, then the priest shall set apart the lesion of the scall seven days.

32 And the priest shall see the lesion on the seventh day, and behold, the scall has not spread, and there is no yellowish hair in it, and the appearance of the scall is not hollow beneath the skin;

33 then the skin shall be shaved, but the scall shall not be shaved, and the priest shall set apart the scall seven days a second time.

34 And the priest shall see the scall on the seventh day, and behold, the scall has not spread in the skin after he has been shaved, and the appearance of the scall is not hollow beneath the skin; then the priest shall cleanse him, and when he has washed his garments, he shall be clean.

35 But if, with spreading, the scall spreads in the skin after he has been cleansed,

36 then the priest shall see, and behold, the scall has spread in the skin; the priest shall not examine concerning the yellow hair, because he is unclean.

37 But if the scall remains before him in its place and black hair springs up in it, the scall has healed; he is clean, and the priest shall cleanse him.

38 And if there arise in a man or a woman, in the skin of his flesh, shining spots that shine whitish,

39 then the priest shall see, and behold, in the skin of his flesh are shining spots that shine whitish; it is alphos; he is clean; it blossoms in the skin of his flesh; he is clean.

40 And if the head of anyone loses its hair, he is bald; he is clean.

41 But if his head loses its hair toward the front, he is bald in front; he is clean.

42 But if there arises in his baldness or in his frontal baldness a white or reddening lesion, it is leprosy in his baldness or in his frontal baldness;

43 and the priest shall see him, and behold, the appearance of the lesion is white, reddening in his baldness or in his frontal baldness, like the appearance of leprosy in the skin of his flesh;

44 he is a leprous person; with defiling the priest shall defile him; his lesion is on his head.

45 And the leprous person in whom the lesion is, let his garments be loosened and his head uncovered, and let him wrap something around his mouth, and he shall be called unclean.

46 All the days for which the lesion is upon him, being unclean, he shall be unclean; he shall sit apart; his dwelling shall be outside the camp.

47 And if there arises in a garment a leprous lesion, in a woolen garment or in a flaxen garment,

48 or in warp or in woof or in the linen things or in the woolen things or in a hide or in any worked hide,

49 and the lesion becomes greenish or reddish in the hide or in the garment or in the warp or in the woof or in any vessel worked from hide, it is a leprous lesion, and it shall be shown to the priest.

50 And the priest shall see the lesion, and the priest shall set the lesion apart seven days.

51 And the priest shall see the lesion on the seventh day; but if the lesion spreads in the garment or in the warp or in the woof or in the hide, in regard to anything for which hides are made in the work, the lesion is a persistent leprosy; it is unclean.

52 He shall burn the garment or the warp or the woof among the woolen things or among the linen things or any vessel of hide in which the lesion is, because it is a persistent leprosy; it shall be burned with fire.

53 But if the priest sees, and the lesion does not spread in the garment or in the warp or in the woof or in any vessel of hide,

54 then the priest shall command, and he shall wash that upon which the lesion is, and the priest shall set the lesion apart seven days a second time.

55 And the priest shall see the lesion after it has been washed, and if the lesion has not changed its appearance and the lesion does not spread, it is unclean; it shall be burned with fire; it is fixed in the garment or in the warp or in the woof.

56 And if the priest sees, and the lesion is dim after it has been washed, he shall tear it away from the garment or from the hide or from the warp or from the woof.

57 But if it still appears in the garment or in the warp or in the woof or in any vessel of hide, it is a blossoming leprosy; that in which the lesion is shall be burned with fire.

58 And the garment or the warp or the woof or every vessel of hide that is washed and from which the lesion departs shall also be washed a second time and shall be clean.

59 This is the law of a leprous lesion in a woolen or flaxen garment or warp or woof or any vessel of hide, for cleansing it or defiling it.

Chapter 14

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 This is the law of the leprous person, on whatever day he is cleansed; and he shall be brought to the priest.

3 And the priest shall go out, outside the camp, and the priest shall see, and behold, the leprous lesion has healed from the leprous person;

4 and the priest shall command, and they shall take for the one who has been cleansed two living clean birds and cedar wood and spun scarlet and hyssop.

5 And the priest shall command, and they shall slaughter the one bird into an earthen vessel over living water.

6 And as for the living bird, he shall take it and the cedar wood and the spun scarlet and the hyssop and shall dip them and the living bird into the blood of the bird that was slaughtered over living water;

7 and he shall sprinkle upon the one cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and he shall be clean; and he shall release the living bird into the plain.

8 And the one who has been cleansed shall wash his garments and shall shave off all his hair and shall bathe in water and shall be clean; and after these things he shall enter into the camp and shall remain outside his house seven days.

9 And it shall be on the seventh day that he shall shave off all his hair: his head and his beard and his eyebrows, and he shall shave off all his hair; and he shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water and shall be clean. –

10 And on the eighth day he shall take two year-old unblemished lambs and one year-old unblemished sheep and three tenths of fine flour as a sacrifice, mixed with oil, and one kotyle of oil;

11 and the priest who cleanses shall stand the person who is being cleansed and these things before the Lord at the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

12 And the priest shall take the one lamb and bring it for trespass, and the kotyle of oil, and shall set it apart as a separation before the Lord.

13 And they shall slaughter the lamb in the place where they slaughter the whole burnt offerings and the things concerning sin, in a holy place; for the thing concerning sin is like the thing of trespass; it belongs to the priest; it is Holy of Holies.

14 And the priest shall take from the blood of the thing of trespass, and the priest shall place it upon the lobe of the right ear of the one who is being cleansed and upon the tip of the right hand and upon the tip of the right foot.

15 And the priest, taking from the kotyle of oil, shall pour it upon the priest’s left hand;

16 and he shall dip his right finger into the oil that is upon his left hand and shall sprinkle with his finger seven times before the Lord.

17 And the remaining oil that is in his hand the priest shall place upon the lobe of the right ear of the one who is being cleansed and upon the tip of the right hand and upon the tip of the right foot, upon the place of the blood of the thing of trespass.

18 And the remaining oil that is upon the priest’s hand, the priest shall place upon the head of the one who has been cleansed, and the priest shall make atonement concerning him before the Lord.

19 And the priest shall make the thing concerning sin, and the priest shall make atonement concerning the unclean person who is being cleansed from his sin; and after this the priest shall slaughter the whole burnt offering.

20 And the priest shall offer the whole burnt offering and the sacrifice upon the altar before the Lord; and the priest shall make atonement concerning him, and he shall be cleansed.

21 But if he is poor and his hand does not find enough, he shall take one lamb for that in which he trespassed, as a removal offering, so as to make atonement concerning him, and a tenth of fine flour mixed with oil as a sacrifice and one kotyle of oil,

22 and two turtledoves or two young pigeons, whatever his hand has found, and the one shall be concerning sin and the one as a whole burnt offering.

23 And he shall bring them on the eighth day for cleansing him, to the priest, at the door of the tabernacle of testimony before the Lord.

24 And the priest, taking the lamb of trespass and the kotyle of oil, shall place them as a presentation before the Lord.

25 And he shall slaughter the lamb of trespass, and the priest shall take from the blood of the thing of trespass and shall place it upon the lobe of the right ear of the one who is being cleansed and upon the tip of the right hand and upon the tip of the right foot.

26 And the priest shall pour some of the oil upon the priest’s left hand;

27 and the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his left hand seven times before the Lord.

28 And the priest shall place some of the oil that is upon his hand upon the lobe of the right ear of the one who is being cleansed and upon the tip of his right hand and upon the tip of his right foot, upon the place of the blood of the thing of trespass.

29 And the remainder of the oil that is upon the priest’s hand he shall place upon the head of the one who has been cleansed, and the priest shall make atonement concerning him before the Lord.

30 And he shall make one of the turtledoves or of the young pigeons, according to what his hand has found,

31 the one concerning sin and the one as a whole burnt offering with the sacrifice; and the priest shall make atonement concerning the one who is being cleansed before the Lord.

32 This is the law for one in whom is the leprous lesion and whose hand does not find enough for his cleansing.

33 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

34 Whenever you enter into the land of the Chanaanites, which I give to you as a possession, and I give a leprous lesion in the houses of the land acquired by you,

35 then he whose house it is shall come and report to the priest, saying: Something like a lesion has appeared to me in the house.

36 And the priest shall command that the house be cleared out before the priest enters to see the lesion, so that the things that are in the house certainly do not become unclean; and after these things the priest shall enter to examine the house.

37 And he shall see the lesion in the walls of the house, greenish or reddish cavities, and their appearance lower than the walls;

38 and the priest, going out from the house to the door of the house, shall set the house apart seven days.

39 And the priest shall return on the seventh day and shall see the house, and behold, the lesion has not spread in the walls of the house;

40 and the priest shall command, and they shall take out the stones in which the lesion is, and they shall cast them outside the city into an unclean place.

41 And they shall scrape the house inside all around and shall pour out the dust outside the city into an unclean place.

42 And they shall take other scraped stones and put them in place of the stones, and they shall take other dust and plaster the house.

43 But if the lesion comes again and springs up in the house after the stones have been taken out and after the house has been scraped and after it has been plastered,

44 then the priest shall enter and shall see; if the lesion has spread in the house, it is a persistent leprosy in the house; it is unclean.

45 And they shall pull down the house, and they shall carry its timbers and its stones and all the dust outside the city into an unclean place.

46 And the one who enters into the house during all the days for which it is set apart shall be unclean until evening.

47 And the one who sleeps in the house shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening; and the one who eats in the house shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening.

48 But if the priest, arriving, enters and sees, and behold, with spreading the lesion does not spread in the house after the house has been plastered, then the priest shall cleanse the house, because the lesion has healed.

49 And he shall take, to purify the house, two living clean birds and cedar wood and spun scarlet and hyssop;

50 and he shall slaughter the one bird into an earthen vessel over living water,

51 and he shall take the cedar wood and the spun scarlet and the hyssop and the living bird and shall dip it into the blood of the bird that was slaughtered over living water and shall sprinkle the house with them seven times.

52 And he shall purify the house with the blood of the bird and with the living water and with the living bird and with the cedar wood and with the hyssop and with the spun scarlet.

53 And he shall release the living bird outside the city into the plain and shall make atonement concerning the house, and it shall be clean.

54 This is the law concerning every leprous lesion and scall,

55 and the leprosy of a garment and a house,

56 and a scar and a mark and the shining spot,

57 and for explaining on what day it is unclean and on what day it shall be cleansed; this is the law of leprosy.

Chapter 15

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: For any man in whom there is a discharge from his body, his discharge is unclean.

3 And this is the law of his uncleanness: whether seed flows from his body from the discharge by which his body has become constricted through the discharge, this is his uncleanness in him; all the days of the discharge of his body, by which his body has become constricted through the discharge, it is his uncleanness.

4 Every bed upon which the man with the seminal discharge sleeps is unclean, and every vessel upon which the man with the seminal discharge sits shall be unclean.

5 And a person who touches his bed shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

6 And the one who sits upon the vessel upon which the man with the seminal discharge sits shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

7 And the one who touches the body of the man with the seminal discharge shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

8 But if the man with the seminal discharge spits upon the clean person, he shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

9 And every saddle of a donkey upon which the man with the seminal discharge rides shall be unclean until evening.

10 And everyone who touches anything that is beneath him shall be unclean until evening; and the one who carries them shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

11 And anyone whom the man with the seminal discharge touches while he has not washed his hands shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water and shall be unclean until evening.

12 And an earthen vessel that the man with the seminal discharge touches shall be broken; and a wooden vessel shall be rinsed with water and shall be clean. –

13 But if the man with the seminal discharge is cleansed from his discharge, then seven days shall be counted for him for cleansing, and he shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water and shall be clean.

14 And on the eighth day he shall take for himself two turtledoves or two young pigeons and shall bring them before the Lord at the doors of the tabernacle of testimony and shall give them to the priest.

15 And the priest shall make them, one concerning sin and one as a whole burnt offering, and the priest shall make atonement concerning him before the Lord for his discharge.

16 And a man from whom an emission of semen goes out shall bathe his whole body in water and shall be unclean until evening.

17 And every garment and every hide upon which there is an emission of semen shall also be washed with water and shall be unclean until evening.

18 And a woman, if a man lies with her with an emission of semen, they shall both bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

19 And a woman, if she is flowing with blood and her discharge is in her body, shall be in her menstruation seven days; everyone who touches her shall be unclean until evening.

20 And everything upon which she lies during her menstruation shall be unclean, and everything upon which she sits shall be unclean.

21 And everyone who touches her bed shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water and shall be unclean until evening.

22 And everyone who touches any vessel upon which she sits shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening.

23 But if he touches her while she is on her bed or upon the vessel upon which she sits, he shall be unclean until evening.

24 But if anyone lies in bed with her and her uncleanness comes upon him, then he shall be unclean seven days, and every bed upon which he sleeps shall be unclean.

25 And a woman, if she flows with a flow of blood for more days, not at the time of her menstruation, or if she also flows after her menstruation, all the days of the flow of her uncleanness shall be like the days of her menstruation; she shall be unclean.

26 And every bed upon which she sleeps during all the days of her flow shall be for her like the bed of her menstruation, and every vessel upon which she sits shall be unclean according to the uncleanness of her menstruation.

27 Everyone who touches her shall be unclean and shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water and shall be unclean until evening.

28 But if she is cleansed from the discharge, then seven days shall be counted for her, and after these she shall be cleansed.

29 And on the eighth day she shall take for herself two turtledoves or two young pigeons and shall bring them to the priest at the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

30 And the priest shall make the one concerning sin and the one as a whole burnt offering, and the priest shall make atonement concerning her before the Lord for the flow of her uncleanness.

31 And you shall make the sons of Israel cautious of their uncleannesses, and they shall not die because of their uncleanness when they defile my tabernacle that is among them. –

32 This is the law of the man with the seminal discharge and of anyone from whom an emission of semen goes out so that he is defiled by it,

33 and of the woman flowing blood in her menstruation and the one with a seminal discharge in his discharge, for the male or for the female, and of the man who lies with one sitting apart.

Chapter 16

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses after the two sons of Aaron died when they brought strange fire before the Lord, and they died.

2 And the Lord said to Moses: Speak to Aaron your brother, and let him not enter at every time into the holy place inside the veil, before the propitiatory that is upon the ark of testimony, and he shall not die; for I shall appear in a cloud upon the propitiatory.

3 Thus Aaron shall enter into the holy place: with a calf from the cattle concerning sin and a ram as a whole burnt offering.

4 And he shall put on a sanctified linen tunic, and linen drawers shall be upon his body, and he shall gird himself with a linen sash and put on a linen turban; they are holy garments, and he shall bathe his whole body in water and put them on.

5 And from the congregation of the sons of Israel he shall take two male kids from the goats concerning sin and one ram as a whole burnt offering.

6 And Aaron shall bring the calf concerning his sin and shall make atonement concerning himself and his house.

7 And he shall take the two male kids and stand them before the Lord beside the door of the tabernacle of testimony.

8 And Aaron shall place lots upon the two male kids, one lot for the Lord and one lot for the one sent away.

9 And Aaron shall bring the male kid upon which the lot for the Lord fell and shall offer it concerning sin.

10 And the male kid upon which the lot of the one sent away fell, he shall stand it alive before the Lord, to make atonement upon it so as to send it away for dismissal; he shall release it into the wilderness. –

11 And Aaron shall bring the calf concerning his sin, his own and that of his house alone, and shall make atonement concerning himself and his house, and he shall slaughter the calf concerning his own sin.

12 And he shall take the fire-pan full of coals of fire from the altar that is before the Lord and shall fill his hands with fine compounded incense and bring it inside the veil.

13 And he shall place the incense upon the fire before the Lord, and the vapor of the incense shall cover the propitiatory that is upon the testimonies, and he shall not die.

14 And he shall take some of the blood of the calf and shall sprinkle it with his finger upon the propitiatory toward the east; before the propitiatory he shall sprinkle some of the blood with his finger seven times.

15 And he shall slaughter the male kid concerning the sin of the people before the Lord and shall bring some of its blood inside the veil and shall do with its blood in the manner that he did with the blood of the calf, and he shall sprinkle its blood upon the propitiatory, before the propitiatory.

16 And he shall make atonement for the holy place from the uncleannesses of the sons of Israel and from their injustices concerning all their sins; and thus he shall do to the tabernacle of testimony that was built among them in the midst of their uncleanness.

17 And no person shall be in the tabernacle of testimony when he enters to make atonement in the holy place, until he comes out; and he shall make atonement concerning himself and his house and concerning the whole congregation of the sons of Israel.

18 And he shall go out to the altar that is before the Lord and shall make atonement upon it; and he shall take some of the blood of the calf and some of the blood of the male kid and shall place it upon the horns of the altar all around.

19 And he shall sprinkle some of the blood upon it with his finger seven times and shall cleanse it and sanctify it from the uncleannesses of the sons of Israel.

20 And he shall finish making atonement for the holy place and the tabernacle of testimony and the altar, and concerning the priests he shall cleanse; and he shall bring the living male kid.

21 And Aaron shall place his hands upon the head of the living male kid and shall declare over it all the lawless deeds of the sons of Israel and all their injustices and all their sins, and shall place them upon the head of the living male kid and shall send it away by the hand of a ready person into the wilderness.

22 And the male kid shall take their injustices upon itself into an untrodden land, and he shall send away the male kid into the wilderness.

23 And Aaron shall enter into the tabernacle of testimony and shall take off the linen robe that he had put on when he entered into the holy place and shall lay it there.

24 And he shall bathe his body in water in a holy place and shall put on his robe, and going out, he shall make his whole offering and the whole offering of the people and shall make atonement concerning himself and his house and concerning the people as concerning the priests.

25 And the fat concerning sins he shall offer upon the altar.

26 And the one who sends away the male kid that was separated for release shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water, and after these things he shall enter into the camp.

27 And the calf concerning sin and the male kid concerning sin, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the holy place, they shall carry them outside the camp and shall burn them with fire, both their hides and their flesh and their dung.

28 And the one who burns them shall wash his garments and bathe his body in water, and after these things he shall enter into the camp.

29 And this shall be an eternal ordinance for you: in the seventh month, on the tenth of the month, humble your souls, and you shall do no work, the native and the proselyte who is attached among you.

30 For on this day he shall make atonement concerning you, to cleanse you from all your sins before the Lord, and you shall be cleansed.

31 It shall be a Sabbath of Sabbaths, a rest for you, and you shall humble your souls; it is an eternal ordinance.

32 The priest shall make atonement, the one whom they anoint and whose hands they perfect to serve as priest after his father, and he shall put on the linen robe, a holy robe.

33 And he shall make atonement for the Holy of Holies, and he shall make atonement for the tabernacle of testimony and the altar, and he shall make atonement concerning the priests and concerning the whole congregation.

34 And this shall be an eternal ordinance for you, to make atonement concerning the sons of Israel for all their sins; once in the year it shall be done, just as the Lord instructed Moses.

Chapter 17

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to all the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: This is the word that the Lord commanded, saying:

3 Any person from the sons of Israel or from the proselytes who are attached among you, who slaughters a calf or sheep or goat in the camp or who slaughters it outside the camp

4 and does not bring it to the door of the tabernacle of testimony so as to make it a whole burnt offering or a salvation acceptable to the Lord for an aroma of fragrance, and whoever slaughters it outside and does not bring it to the door of the tabernacle of testimony so as not to offer a gift to the Lord before the tabernacle of the Lord, blood shall be reckoned to that person; he has shed blood; that soul shall be utterly destroyed from its people.

5 This is so that the sons of Israel may bring their sacrifices, as many as they themselves slaughter in the plains, and they shall bring them to the Lord at the doors of the tabernacle of testimony, to the priest, and shall sacrifice them as a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord.

6 And the priest shall pour the blood upon the altar all around before the Lord beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony and shall offer the fat as an aroma of fragrance to the Lord.

7 And they shall no longer sacrifice their sacrifices to the vain things after which they themselves prostitute themselves; it shall be an eternal ordinance for you throughout your generations.

8 And you shall say to them: Any person from the sons of Israel and from the sons of the proselytes who are attached among you who makes a whole burnt offering or a sacrifice

9 and does not bring it to the door of the tabernacle of testimony to make it for the Lord, that person shall be utterly destroyed from his people.

10 And any person from the sons of Israel or from the proselytes who are attached among you who eats any blood, I shall set my face against the soul that eats the blood and shall destroy it from its people.

11 For the soul of all flesh is its blood, and I have given it to you upon the altar to make atonement concerning your souls; for its blood shall make atonement instead of the soul.

12 Therefore I have said to the sons of Israel: No soul from among you shall eat blood, and the proselyte who is attached among you shall not eat blood.

13 And any person from the sons of Israel and from the proselytes who are attached among you who hunts as game a wild animal or bird that is eaten shall pour out the blood and cover it with earth.

14 For the soul of all flesh is its blood, and I said to the sons of Israel: You shall not eat the blood of any flesh, because the soul of all flesh is its blood; everyone who eats it shall be utterly destroyed.

15 And every soul that eats a carcass or something caught by a wild beast, among the natives or among the proselytes, shall wash his garments and bathe in water and shall be unclean until evening, and then he shall be clean.

16 But if he does not wash his garments and does not bathe his body in water, then he shall bear his lawlessness.

Chapter 18

1 And the Lord said to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: I am the Lord your God.

3 You shall not do according to the practices of the land of Egypt, in which you dwelt, and you shall not do according to the practices of the land of Chanaan, into which I am bringing you there, and you shall not walk in their ordinances.

4 You shall do my judgments and keep my ordinances, to walk in them; I am the Lord your God.

5 And you shall keep all my ordinances and all my judgments and shall do them, which, if a person does, he shall live by them; I am the Lord your God.

6 No person shall approach any relative of his flesh to uncover shamefulness; I am the Lord.

7 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your father and the shamefulness of your mother; for she is your mother, and you shall not uncover her shamefulness.

8 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your father’s wife; it is your father’s shamefulness.

9 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your sister from your father or from your mother, whether born within or born outside.

10 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your son’s daughter or your daughter’s daughter, because it is your shamefulness.

11 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of the daughter of your father’s wife; she is your sister by the same father; you shall not uncover her shamefulness.

12 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your father’s sister, for she is a relative of your father.

13 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your mother’s sister, for she is a relative of your mother.

14 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your father’s brother, and you shall not enter into his wife, for she is your relative.

15 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your daughter-in-law, for she is your son’s wife; you shall not uncover her shamefulness.

16 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of your brother’s wife; it is your brother’s shamefulness.

17 You shall not uncover the shamefulness of a woman and her daughter; you shall not take her son’s daughter or her daughter’s daughter to uncover their shamefulness, for they are your relatives; it is an impiety.

18 You shall not take a woman in addition to her sister as a rival, to uncover her shamefulness in addition to her while she is still living.

19 And you shall not approach a woman in the separation of her uncleanness to uncover her shamefulness.

20 And you shall not give the bed of your seed to the wife of your neighbor, to be defiled with her.

21 And you shall not give any of your seed to serve a ruler, and you shall not profane the holy name; I am the Lord.

22 And you shall not lie with a male in the bed of a woman, for it is an abomination.

23 And you shall not give your bed to any quadruped for insemination, to be defiled with it, and a woman shall not stand before any quadruped to be mounted, for it is loathsome.

24 Do not defile yourselves by any of these things, for by all these things the nations that I send away from before you were defiled,

25 and the land was defiled, and I repaid injustice to them because of it, and the land was disgusted with those dwelling upon it.

26 And you shall keep all my ordinances and all my commands and shall not do any of all these abominations, the native and the proselyte who has come among you.

27 For all these abominations were done by the people of the land who were before you, and the land was defiled;

28 and this is so that the land may not be disgusted with you when you defile it, in the manner that it was disgusted with the nations that were before you.

29 Because everyone who does any of all these abominations—the souls that do them shall be utterly destroyed from their people.

30 And you shall keep my commands so that you do not do any of all the abominated ordinances that occurred before you, and you shall not be defiled by them, because I am the Lord your God.

Chapter 19

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the congregation of the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: You shall be holy, because I am holy, the Lord your God.

3 Let each one fear his father and his mother, and you shall keep my Sabbaths; I am the Lord your God.

4 You shall not follow idols, and you shall not make molten gods for yourselves; I am the Lord your God. –

5 And if you sacrifice a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord, you shall sacrifice it as acceptable for you.

6 On whatever day you sacrifice it, it shall be eaten, and on the next day; and if it remains until the third day, it shall be burned with fire.

7 But if, with eating, it is eaten on the third day, it is unsacrificed; it shall not be accepted.

8 And the one who eats it shall bear sin, because he profaned the holy things of the Lord; and the souls that eat it shall be utterly destroyed from their people.

9 And when you reap the harvest of your land, you shall not completely reap the harvest of your field, and you shall not gather the things that fall from your harvest.

10 And you shall not gather your vineyard again, nor shall you gather the grapes of your vineyard; you shall leave them for the poor and the proselyte; I am the Lord your God.

11 You shall not steal. You shall not lie. Each one shall not slander his neighbor.

12 And you shall not swear by my name for an unjust thing, and you shall not profane the name of your God; I am the Lord your God.

13 You shall not wrong your neighbor, and you shall not rob, and the wage of the hired worker shall certainly not sleep with you until morning.

14 You shall not speak evil of a deaf person, and you shall not place a stumbling block before a blind person, and you shall fear the Lord your God; I am the Lord your God.

15 You shall not do injustice in judgment; you shall not accept the face of a poor person, nor shall you admire the face of a powerful person; in righteousness you shall judge your neighbor.

16 You shall not go by deceit in your nation; you shall not conspire against the blood of your neighbor; I am the Lord your God.

17 You shall not hate your brother in your mind; with reproof you shall reprove your neighbor, and you shall not bear sin because of him.

18 And your hand shall not avenge you, and you shall not bear a grudge against the sons of your people, and you shall love your neighbor as yourself; I am the Lord.

19 You shall keep my law; you shall not mate your animals with a different yoke, and you shall not sow your vineyard with diverse seed, and you shall not put upon yourself an adulterated garment woven from two things.

20 And if anyone lies with a woman with an emission of semen, and she is a female servant reserved for a man and she has not been ransomed with a ransom or freedom has not been given to her, there shall be an examination for them; they shall not die, because she had not been freed.

21 And he shall bring for his trespass to the Lord, beside the door of the tabernacle of testimony, a ram of trespass.

22 And the priest shall make atonement concerning him with the ram of trespass before the Lord concerning the sin that he sinned, and the sin that he sinned shall be forgiven him.

23 And when you enter into the land that the Lord your God gives you and plant every food-bearing tree, then you shall cleanse away its uncleanness all around; its fruit shall be uncleansed all around for you three years; it shall not be eaten.

24 And in the fourth year all its fruit shall be holy, praiseworthy to the Lord.

25 But in the fifth year you shall eat the fruit; its produce shall be an addition for you; I am the Lord your God.

26 Do not eat upon the mountains, and you shall not practice augury or observe birds for omens.

27 You shall not make a sisoe from the hair of your head, nor shall you destroy the appearance of your beard.

28 And you shall not make incisions for a soul in your body, and you shall not make tattooed letters upon yourselves; I am the Lord your God.

29 You shall not profane your daughter by prostituting her, and the land shall not prostitute itself and the land shall not be filled with lawlessness.

30 You shall keep my Sabbaths and shall fear because of my holy things; I am the Lord.

31 You shall not follow belly-speakers, and you shall not join yourselves to enchanters, to be defiled by them; I am the Lord your God.

32 You shall rise up before the face of a gray-haired person and shall honor the face of an elder and shall fear your God; I am the Lord your God.

33 And if any proselyte approaches you in your land, you shall not afflict him.

34 The proselyte who comes to you shall be like the native among you, and you shall love him as yourself, because you became proselytes in the land of Egypt; I am the Lord your God.

35 You shall not do injustice in judgment, in measures and in weights and in balances.

36 Just balances and just weights and a just chous shall be for you; I am the Lord your God who brought you out from the land of Egypt.

37 And you shall keep all my law and all my commands and shall do them; I am the Lord your God.

Chapter 20

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 And to the sons of Israel you shall speak: If anyone from the sons of Israel or from the proselytes who have come to Israel gives any of his seed to a ruler, by death let him be put to death; the nation that is upon the land shall stone him with stones.

3 And I shall set my face against that person and shall destroy him from his people, because he gave some of his seed to a ruler, so that he might defile my holy things and profane the name of the things sanctified to me.

4 But if, with overlooking, the natives of the land overlook with their eyes that person when he gives some of his seed to a ruler, so as not to kill him,

5 then I shall set my face against that person and his kin and shall destroy him and all those who are of one mind with him, so as to prostitute him to the rulers, from their people.

6 And a soul that follows belly-speakers or enchanters so as to prostitute itself after them, I shall set my face against that soul and shall destroy it from its people.

7 And you shall be holy, because I am holy, the Lord your God.

8 And you shall keep my commands and shall do them; I am the Lord who sanctifies you.

9 Any person who speaks evil of his father or his mother, by death let him be put to death; he spoke evil of his father or his mother; he shall be guilty.

10 A person who commits adultery with a man’s wife, or who commits adultery with the wife of his neighbor, by death let them be put to death, both the one committing adultery and the one with whom adultery is committed.

11 If anyone lies with his father’s wife, he has uncovered the shamefulness of his father; by death let both be put to death; they are guilty.

12 And if anyone lies with his daughter-in-law, by death let both be put to death, for they have acted impiously; they are guilty.

13 And whoever lies with a male in the bed of a woman, both have done an abomination; let them be put to death; they are guilty.

14 Whoever takes a woman and her mother, it is lawlessness; they shall burn him and them with fire, and there shall be no lawlessness among you.

15 And whoever gives his lying down in a quadruped, by death let him be put to death, and you shall kill the quadruped.

16 And a woman who approaches any animal to be mounted by it, you shall kill the woman and the animal; by death let them be put to death; they are guilty.

17 Whoever takes his sister from his father or from his mother and sees her shamefulness, and she sees his shamefulness, it is a reproach; they shall be utterly destroyed before the sons of their race; he uncovered the shamefulness of his sister; they shall bear sin.

18 And a man who lies with a woman sitting apart and uncovers her shamefulness has uncovered her fountain, and she has uncovered the flow of her blood; both shall be utterly destroyed from their race.

19 And you shall not uncover the shamefulness of your father’s sister or your mother’s sister, for he has uncovered the kinship; they shall bear sin.

20 Whoever lies with his female relative has uncovered the shamefulness of his kin; they shall die childless.

21 Whoever takes his brother’s wife, it is uncleanness; he has uncovered the shamefulness of his brother; they shall die childless.

22 And you shall keep all my commands and my judgments and shall do them, and the land into which I am bringing you there to dwell upon it shall certainly not be disgusted with you.

23 And you shall by no means walk in the ordinances of the nations that I send away from you, because they did all these things and I abominated them.

24 And I said to you: You shall inherit their land, and I shall give it to you as a possession, a land flowing with milk and honey; I am the Lord your God, who separated you from all the nations.

25 And you shall separate them between the clean animals and between the unclean animals and between the clean birds and the unclean, and you shall not make your souls abominable by the animals and by the birds and by any of the creeping things of the earth that I separated for you in uncleanness.

26 And you shall be holy to me, because I am holy, the Lord your God, who separated you from all the nations to be mine.

27 And a man or a woman who becomes among them a belly-speaker or an enchanter, by death let both be put to death; stone them with stones; they are guilty.

Chapter 21

1 And the Lord said to Moses, saying: Say to the priests, the sons of Aaron, and you shall say to them: They shall not be defiled among the souls in their nation,

2 except by their nearest relative, by a father and mother and sons and daughters, by a brother,

3 and by a virgin sister who is near to him, who has not been given to a man; by these he shall be defiled.

4 He shall not be defiled suddenly among his people, to his profanation.

5 And you shall not shave baldness on the head for a dead person, and they shall not shave the appearance of the beard, and they shall not cut incisions into their flesh.

6 They shall be holy to their God and shall not profane the name of their God, for they themselves offer the sacrifices of the Lord, gifts of their God, and they shall be holy.

7 They shall not take a woman who is a prostitute and profaned, or a woman cast out from her husband, for he is holy to the Lord his God.

8 And you shall sanctify him; he offers the gifts of the Lord your God. He shall be holy, because I am holy, the Lord who sanctifies them.

9 And if a daughter of a man who is a priest is profaned by prostituting herself, she profanes the name of her father; she shall be burned upon fire.

10 And the great priest from among his brothers, upon whose head the oil of the anointed one has been poured and who has been perfected to put on the garments, shall not remove the turban from his head and shall not tear his garments.

11 And he shall not enter upon any soul that has died; he shall not be defiled by his father or by his mother.

12 And he shall not go out from the holy things and shall not profane the thing sanctified to his God, because the holy oil, the anointed thing of God, is upon him; I am the Lord.

13 He shall take a virgin woman from his race.

14 But a widow and one cast out and one profaned and a prostitute, these he shall not take; rather, he shall take as wife a virgin from his race.

15 And he shall not profane his seed among his people; I am the Lord who sanctifies him.

16 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

17 Say to Aaron: A person from your race throughout your generations, whoever has a blemish in him, shall not approach to offer the gifts of his God.

18 Every person in whom there is a blemish shall not approach: a person who is lame or blind or has a mutilated nose or a cut ear,

19 or a person in whom there is a broken hand or a broken foot,

20 or one who is hunchbacked or has a white spot or has a film over the eyes, or a person in whom there is severe scabies or lichen, or who has one testicle.

21 Everyone in whom there is a blemish, from the seed of Aaron the priest, shall not draw near to offer the sacrifices to your God; because there is a blemish in him, he shall not approach to offer the gifts of God.

22 He shall eat the gifts of God, the Holy of Holies and some of the holy things.

23 Except he shall not approach the veil and shall not draw near the altar, because he has a blemish; and he shall not profane the holy place of his God, because I am the Lord who sanctifies them.

24 And Moses spoke to Aaron and his sons and to all the sons of Israel.

Chapter 22

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Say to Aaron and to his sons, and let them keep away from the holy things of the sons of Israel, and they shall not profane my holy name in the things that they themselves sanctify to me; I am the Lord.

3 Say to them: Throughout your generations, every person from all your seed who approaches the holy things, whatever the sons of Israel sanctify to the Lord, while his uncleanness is upon him, that soul shall be utterly destroyed from me; I am the Lord your God.

4 And a person from the seed of Aaron the priest, if he is leprous or has a seminal discharge, shall not eat from the holy things until he is cleansed; and the one who touches any uncleanness of a soul, or a person from whom an emission of semen goes out,

5 or whoever touches any unclean creeping thing that defiles him, or touches a person by whom he defiles himself according to all his uncleanness,

6 a soul that touches them shall be unclean until evening; he shall not eat from the holy things unless he bathes his body in water.

7 And the sun shall set, and he shall be clean, and then he shall eat from the holy things, because it is his bread.

8 He shall not eat a carcass or something caught by a wild beast, to be defiled by them; I am the Lord.

9 And they shall keep my observances, so that they do not bear sin because of them and die because of them if they profane them; I am the Lord God who sanctifies them. –

10 And no foreigner shall eat holy things; a sojourner of a priest or a hired worker shall not eat holy things.

11 But if a priest acquires a soul as a possession with silver, this one shall eat from his bread; and those born in his house, these also shall eat from his bread.

12 And if a daughter of a man who is a priest becomes the wife of a foreign man, she shall not eat from the firstfruits of the holy things.

13 And if a daughter of a priest becomes a widow or is cast out, but there was no seed for her, she shall return to her paternal house as in her youth; she shall eat from the bread of her father. And no foreigner shall eat from them.

14 And a person who eats holy things in ignorance shall also add its fifth to it and shall give the holy thing to the priest.

15 And they shall not profane the holy things of the sons of Israel, which they themselves remove for the Lord,

16 and they shall bring upon themselves the lawlessness of trespass when they eat their holy things, because I am the Lord who sanctifies them.

17 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

18 Speak to Aaron and to his sons and to the whole congregation of Israel, and you shall say to them: Any person from the sons of Israel or from the sons of the proselytes who are attached to them in Israel who offers his gifts according to any confession of theirs or according to any choice of theirs, whatever they offer to God as a whole burnt offering,

19 acceptable for you shall be unblemished males from the herds and from the sheep and from the goats.

20 Anything that has a blemish in it they shall not bring to the Lord, because it shall not be acceptable for you.

21 And a person who offers a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord, distinguishing a vow according to a choice or at your festivals, from the herds or from the sheep, shall be unblemished for acceptance; no blemish shall be in it.

22 Anything blind or crushed or with its tongue cut or covered in warts or having severe scabies or lichens, they shall not bring these to the Lord, and you shall not give any of them as an offering upon the altar to the Lord.

23 And a calf or sheep with a cut ear or a docked tail, you shall make them slaughtered things for yourself, but for your vow it shall not be accepted.

24 Anything with its testicles bruised or crushed or cut out or torn away, you shall not bring them to the Lord, and you shall not do this upon your land.

25 And from the hand of a foreigner you shall not offer the gifts of your God from any of these, because corruptions are in them; a blemish is in them; these shall not be accepted for you.

26 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

27 A calf or sheep or goat, when it is born, shall be seven days under its mother, but from the eighth day and beyond it shall be accepted as gifts, an offering to the Lord.

28 And a calf or sheep, her and her young you shall not slaughter on one day.

29 But if you sacrifice a sacrifice, a vow of joy to the Lord, you shall sacrifice it as acceptable for you.

30 On that same day it shall be eaten; you shall not leave any of the flesh until morning; I am the Lord.

31 And you shall keep my commandments and shall do them.

32 And you shall not profane the name of the Holy One, and I shall be sanctified in the midst of the sons of Israel; I am the Lord who sanctifies you,

33 who brought you out from the land of Egypt so as to be your God; I am the Lord.

Chapter 23

1 And the Lord said to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: The feasts of the Lord, which you shall call holy convocations, these are my feasts. –

3 Six days you shall do works, and on the seventh day there shall be Sabbaths, a rest, a holy convocation to the Lord; you shall do no work; it is Sabbaths to the Lord in every dwelling of yours.

4 These are the feasts to the Lord, holy convocations, which you shall call at their appointed times.

5 In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, between the evenings, is Pascha to the Lord.

6 And on the fifteenth day of this month is the feast of unleavened things to the Lord; seven days you shall eat unleavened things.

7 And the first day shall be a holy convocation for you; you shall do no work of service.

8 And you shall bring whole burnt offerings to the Lord for seven days; and the seventh day shall be a holy convocation for you; you shall do no work of service.

9 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

10 Say to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: When you enter into the land that I give you and reap its harvest, then you shall bring a sheaf, the firstfruit of your harvest, to the priest.

11 And he shall offer the sheaf before the Lord, acceptable for you; on the day after the first day the priest shall offer it.

12 And on the day on which you bring the sheaf, you shall make a year-old unblemished sheep as a whole burnt offering to the Lord,

13 and its sacrifice shall be two tenths of fine flour worked up in oil—a sacrifice to the Lord, an aroma of fragrance to the Lord—and its libation shall be the fourth of a hin of wine.

14 And you shall not eat bread or roasted new groats until this same day, until you offer the gifts to your God; it is an eternal ordinance throughout your generations in every dwelling of yours.

15 And you shall count from the day after the Sabbaths, from the day on which you offer the sheaf of the presentation, seven complete weeks;

16 until the day after the last week you shall count fifty days, and you shall offer a new sacrifice to the Lord.

17 From your dwelling you shall offer loaves as a presentation, two loaves; they shall be from two tenths of fine flour; they shall be baked leavened as first produce to the Lord.

18 And with the loaves you shall bring seven year-old unblemished lambs and one calf from the herd and two unblemished rams—they shall be a whole burnt offering to the Lord—and their sacrifices and their libations, a sacrifice, an aroma of fragrance to the Lord.

19 And they shall make one male kid from the goats concerning sin and two year-old lambs as a sacrifice of salvation with the loaves of the first produce.

20 And the priest shall place them with the loaves of the first produce as a presentation before the Lord with the two lambs; they shall be holy to the Lord; they shall belong to the priest who offers them to him.

21 And you shall call this day a convocation; it shall be holy for you; you shall do no work of service on it; it is an eternal ordinance throughout your generations in every dwelling of yours. –

22 And when you reap the harvest of your land, you shall not completely reap the remainder of the harvest of your field when you reap, and you shall not gather the things that fall from your harvest; you shall leave them for the poor and the proselyte; I am the Lord your God.

23 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

24 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: On the first of the seventh month there shall be a rest for you, a memorial of trumpets; it shall be a holy convocation for you.

25 You shall do no work of service and shall bring a whole burnt offering to the Lord.

26 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

27 And on the tenth of this seventh month is a day of atonement; it shall be a holy convocation for you, and you shall humble your souls and bring a whole burnt offering to the Lord.

28 You shall do no work on this same day, for it is a day of atonement for you, to make atonement concerning you before the Lord your God.

29 Every soul that is not humbled on this same day shall be utterly destroyed from its people.

30 And every soul that does work on this same day, that soul shall perish from its people.

31 You shall do no work; it is an eternal ordinance throughout your generations in all your dwellings.

32 It shall be Sabbaths of Sabbaths for you, and you shall humble your souls; from the ninth of the month, from evening until evening, you shall keep your Sabbaths.

33 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

34 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: On the fifteenth of this seventh month is the feast of tents for seven days to the Lord.

35 And the first day is a holy convocation; you shall do no work of service.

36 For seven days you shall bring whole burnt offerings to the Lord; and the eighth day shall be a holy convocation for you, and you shall bring whole burnt offerings to the Lord; it is a closing; you shall do no work of service.

37 These are the feasts to the Lord, which you shall call holy convocations, so as to offer offerings to the Lord, whole burnt offerings and their sacrifices and their libations, each day’s for the day,

38 apart from the Sabbaths of the Lord and apart from your gifts and apart from all your vows and apart from your voluntary offerings, whatever you give to the Lord.

39 And on the fifteenth day of this seventh month, when you have finished the produce of the land, you shall feast to the Lord seven days; on the first day there shall be rest, and on the eighth day rest.

40 And on the first day you shall take beautiful fruit of a tree and adornments of palms and leafy branches of a tree and willows and branches of the chaste tree from a torrent, to rejoice before the Lord your God for seven days

41 of the year; it is an eternal ordinance throughout your generations; in the seventh month you shall feast it.

42 You shall dwell in tents seven days; every native in Israel shall dwell in tents,

43 so that your generations may see that I caused the sons of Israel to dwell in tents when I brought them out from the land of Egypt; I am the Lord your God.

44 And Moses spoke the feasts of the Lord to the sons of Israel.

Chapter 24

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Command the sons of Israel, and let them take for me pure pounded olive oil for light, to burn a lamp continually.

3 Outside the veil in the tabernacle of testimony, Aaron and his sons shall burn it from evening until morning before the Lord continually; it is an eternal ordinance throughout your generations.

4 Upon the pure lampstand you shall burn the lamps before the Lord until morning.

5 And you shall take fine flour and make it into twelve loaves; each one loaf shall be of two tenths.

6 And you shall place them in two sets, six loaves in one set, upon the pure table before the Lord.

7 And you shall place pure frankincense and salt upon the set, and they shall be loaves set before the Lord for remembrance.

8 On the day of the Sabbaths it shall be set before the Lord continually, before the sons of Israel, as an eternal covenant.

9 And it shall belong to Aaron and his sons, and they shall eat them in a holy place, for this is Holy of Holies for him from the things sacrificed to the Lord, an eternal ordinance.

10 And a son of an Israelite woman went out, and he was the son of an Egyptian among the sons of Israel, and the one from the Israelite woman and the Israelite man fought in the camp.

11 And the son of the Israelite woman, having named the Name, cursed, and they brought him to Moses; and the name of his mother was Salomith daughter of Dabri from the tribe of Dan.

12 And they put him into custody, to judge him by the command of the Lord.

13 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

14 Bring the one who cursed outside the camp, and all those who heard shall place their hands upon his head, and the whole congregation shall stone him.

15 And speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: A person who curses a god shall bear sin.

16 But one who names the name of the Lord, by death let him be put to death; let the whole congregation of Israel stone him with stones; whether a proselyte or a native, when he names the name of the Lord, let him die.

17 And a person who strikes the soul of a person and he dies, by death let him be put to death.

18 And whoever strikes an animal and it dies, let him repay soul for soul.

19 And if anyone gives a blemish to his neighbor, as he did to him, so also shall it be done back to him:

20 break for break, eye for eye, tooth for tooth; according as he gives a blemish to the person, so it shall be given to him.

21 Whoever strikes a person and he dies, by death let him be put to death.

22 There shall be one ordinance for the proselyte and for the native, because I am the Lord your God.

23 And Moses spoke to the sons of Israel, and they brought the one who cursed outside the camp and stoned him with stones; and the sons of Israel did just as the Lord instructed Moses.

Chapter 25

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses on Mount Sina, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: If you enter into the land that I give you, then the land that I give you shall rest, Sabbaths to the Lord.

3 Six years you shall sow your field, and six years you shall trim your vine and gather its fruit.

4 But in the seventh year there shall be Sabbaths, a rest for the land, Sabbaths to the Lord; you shall not sow your field, and you shall not trim your vine.

5 And you shall not reap the spontaneous things that rise from your field, and you shall not harvest the grape of your sanctification; it shall be a year of rest for the land.

6 And the Sabbaths of the land shall be food for you and for your male servant and your female servant and your hired worker and the sojourner who is attached to you,

7 and for your animals and for the wild animals that are in your land; all its produce shall be for food.

8 And you shall count for yourself seven rests of years, seven years seven times, and the seven weeks of years shall be for you forty-nine years.

9 And you shall announce with the sound of a trumpet in all your land, in the seventh month, on the tenth of the month; on the day of propitiation you shall announce with a trumpet in all your land.

10 And you shall sanctify the fiftieth year and proclaim a release upon the land to all those dwelling in it; this shall be a sign of a year of release for you, and each one shall depart to his possession, and each one of you shall depart to his fatherland.

11 This sign of release, the fiftieth year, shall be a year for you; you shall not sow, nor shall you reap its spontaneous things that rise, and you shall not harvest its sanctified things,

12 because it is a sign of release; it shall be holy for you; from the plains you shall eat its produce.

13 In the year of its sign of release, each one shall return to his possession.

14 But if you give a sale to your neighbor, or if you acquire something from your neighbor, let no person afflict his neighbor.

15 According to the number of years after the sign you shall acquire it from your neighbor; according to the number of years of produce he shall sell it to you.

16 According as the years are more, you shall increase its acquisition price, and according as the years are fewer, you shall lessen its acquisition price, because thus he sells to you the number of its yields.

17 Let no person afflict his neighbor, and you shall fear the Lord your God; I am the Lord your God.

18 And you shall do all my ordinances and all my judgments, and you shall keep and do them, and you shall dwell upon the land with confidence.

19 And the land shall give its produce, and you shall eat to fullness and shall dwell upon it with confidence.

20 But if you say: What shall we eat in this seventh year if we do not sow or gather our produce?

21 Then I shall send my blessing to you in the sixth year, and it shall make its produce for three years.

22 And you shall sow in the eighth year and shall eat from the old produce; until the ninth year, until its produce comes, you shall eat old things of old things.

23 And the land shall not be sold for confirmation, for the land is mine, because you are proselytes and sojourners before me.

24 And throughout every land of your possession you shall give a ransom for the land. –

25 But if your brother who is with you becomes poor and sells some of his possession, and the kinsman who is nearest to him comes, then he shall ransom the sale of his brother.

26 But if someone has no kinsman and his hand prospers and what is sufficient for his ransom is found for him,

27 then he shall calculate the years of his sale and shall repay the surplus to the person to whom he sold himself, and he shall depart to his possession.

28 But if his hand does not prosper enough to repay him, then the sale shall belong to the one who acquired it until the sixth year of the release; and it shall go out at the release, and he shall depart to his possession.

29 And if anyone sells an inhabited house in a walled city, then its redemption shall be until a year of days is fulfilled; its redemption shall be within that time.

30 But if it is not redeemed until its whole year is fulfilled, the house that is in the city that has a wall shall be confirmed permanently to the one who acquired it throughout his generations, and it shall not go out at the release.

31 But the houses in farmsteads that do not have a wall around them shall be reckoned with the field of the land; they shall always be redeemable and shall go out at the release.

32 And as for the cities of the Levites, the houses in the cities of their possession shall always be redeemable for the Levites.

33 And whoever redeems from the Levites, the sale of their houses in the city of their possession shall also go out at the release, because the houses in the cities of the Levites are their possession in the midst of the sons of Israel.

34 And the fields set apart for their cities shall not be sold, because this is their eternal possession.

35 But if your brother becomes poor and is weak in his hands beside you, you shall support him as a proselyte and a sojourner, and your brother shall live with you.

36 You shall not take interest from him or anything in addition, and you shall fear your God—I am the Lord—and your brother shall live with you.

37 You shall not give him your silver at interest, and you shall not give him your food for increase.

38 I am the Lord your God who brought you out from the land of Egypt to give you the land of Chanaan so as to be your God.

39 But if your brother is humbled beside you and is sold to you, he shall not serve you with the service of a household servant.

40 He shall be with you as a hired worker or a sojourner; until the year of the release he shall work beside you.

41 And he shall go out at the release, and his children with him, and he shall depart to his race; he shall run back to his paternal possession.

42 Because these are my household servants whom I brought out from the land of Egypt, he shall not be sold with the sale of a household servant.

43 You shall not stretch him in labor, and you shall fear the Lord your God.

44 And as many male servants and female servants as you have from the nations that are around you, from them you shall acquire a male slave and a female slave.

45 And from the sons of the sojourners who are among you, from these you shall acquire, and from their relatives, as many as are born in your land; let them be a possession for you.

46 And you shall allot them to your children after you, and they shall be held by you in perpetuity; but from your brothers, the sons of Israel, each one shall not stretch his brother in labors.

47 But if the hand of the proselyte or the sojourner beside you finds means, and your brother, being in need, is sold to the proselyte or the sojourner beside you, to a native-born proselyte,

48 after he is sold to him, there shall be redemption for him; one of his brothers shall ransom him,

49 or his father’s brother or the son of his father’s brother shall ransom him, or one of the relatives of his flesh from his tribe shall ransom him; but if, prospering in his hands, he ransoms himself,

50 then he shall calculate with the one who acquired him from the year in which he sold himself to him until the year of the release, and the silver of his sale shall be as a wage; it shall be year by year with him.

51 But if there are more of the years for anyone, according to these he shall repay his ransom from the silver of his sale.

52 But if few of the years remain until the year of the release, then he shall calculate it for him according to his years and shall repay his ransom.

53 He shall be with him as a hired worker year by year; you shall not stretch him in labor before you.

54 But if he is not ransomed according to these things, he shall go out in the year of the release, he and his children with him.

55 Because the sons of Israel are household servants to me; these are my servants whom I brought out from the land of Egypt; I am the Lord your God.

Chapter 26

1 You shall not make for yourselves handmade things or carved things, nor shall you raise up a pillar for yourselves, nor shall you place a watch-stone in your land to worship it; I am the Lord your God.

2 You shall keep my Sabbaths and shall fear because of my holy things; I am the Lord.

3 If you walk in my commands and keep my commandments and do them,

4 then I shall give you the rain at its appointed time, and the land shall give its produce, and the trees of the plains shall give back their fruit.

5 And the threshing shall overtake the vintage for you, and the vintage shall overtake the sowing, and you shall eat your bread to fullness and shall dwell with security upon your land.

6 And war shall not pass through your land, and I shall give peace in your land, and you shall sleep, and there shall be no one frightening you, and I shall destroy evil wild animals from your land.

7 And you shall pursue your enemies, and they shall fall before you by slaughter.

8 And five of you shall pursue a hundred, and a hundred of you shall pursue myriads, and your enemies shall fall before you by the sword.

9 And I shall look upon you and increase you and multiply you and establish my covenant with you.

10 And you shall eat old things and old things of old things, and you shall carry out old things from before the new.

11 And I shall place my covenant among you, and my soul shall not abominate you.

12 And I shall walk about among you and shall be your God, and you shall be my people.

13 I am the Lord your God who brought you out from the land of Egypt while you were slaves, and I broke the bond of your yoke and led you with boldness.

14 But if you do not obey me or do these commands of mine,

15 but disobey them and your soul is disgusted with my judgments, so that you do not do all my commandments, so as to scatter my covenant,

16 then I also shall do thus to you, and I shall raise up against you distress, both scabies and jaundice, causing your eyes to waste away and your soul to melt, and you shall sow your seed in vain, and your adversaries shall eat it.

17 And I shall set my face against you, and you shall fall before your enemies, and those who hate you shall pursue you, and you shall flee when no one pursues you. –

18 And if up to this point you do not obey me, then I shall add to disciplining you sevenfold for your sins.

19 And I shall break the arrogance of your pride and shall make the heaven iron for you and your earth like bronze,

20 and your strength shall be in vain, and your land shall not give its seed, and the tree of your field shall not give its fruit. –

21 And if after these things you walk crookedly and do not wish to obey me, I shall add seven blows to you according to your sins.

22 And I shall send against you the wild animals of the land, and they shall devour you and utterly consume your animals and make you few, and your roads shall be made desolate. –

23 And if by these things you are not disciplined but walk crookedly toward me,

24 then I also shall walk with you in crooked wrath, and I also shall strike you sevenfold in return for your sins.

25 And I shall bring against you a sword avenging the justice of the covenant, and you shall flee for refuge into your cities; and I shall send death into you, and you shall be delivered into the hands of enemies.

26 When you are afflicted by a famine of bread, ten women shall bake your bread in one oven and shall give back your bread by weight, and you shall eat and certainly shall not be filled. –

27 But if by these things you do not obey me and walk crookedly toward me,

28 then I myself shall walk with you in crooked wrath and shall discipline you sevenfold according to your sins.

29 And you shall eat the flesh of your sons, and you shall eat the flesh of your daughters.

30 And I shall make your pillars desolate and utterly destroy your wooden handmade things and place your carcasses upon the carcasses of your idols, and my soul shall be disgusted with you.

31 And I shall make your cities desolate and utterly desolate your holy places, and I shall certainly not smell the aroma of your sacrifices.

32 And I myself shall utterly desolate your land, and your enemies who dwell in it shall marvel at it.

33 And I shall scatter you among the nations, and the sword passing after you shall utterly consume you; and your land shall be desolate, and your cities shall be desolate.

34 Then the land shall delight in its Sabbaths all the days of its desolation, and you shall be in the land of your enemies; then the land shall keep Sabbath and delight in its Sabbaths.

35 All the days of its desolation it shall keep Sabbath, which it did not keep during your Sabbaths when you dwelt in it.

36 And upon those of you who are left, I shall bring cowardice into their heart in the land of their enemies, and the sound of a leaf being carried shall pursue them, and they shall flee as those fleeing from war and shall fall when no one pursues.

37 And brother shall overlook brother as though in war when no one runs after them, and you shall not be able to withstand your enemies.

38 And you shall perish among the nations, and the land of your enemies shall devour you.

39 And those left from you shall be destroyed because of your sins; in the land of their enemies they shall melt away.

40 And they shall declare their sins and the sins of their fathers, because they transgressed and overlooked me and because they walked crookedly against me,

41 and I walked with them in crooked wrath and shall destroy them in the land of their enemies; then their uncircumcised heart shall be turned, and then they shall be well pleased with their sins.

42 And I shall remember the covenant of Jacob and the covenant of Isaac and the covenant of Abraham, and I shall remember the land.

43 And the land shall be abandoned by them; then the land shall accept its Sabbaths when it is made desolate because of them, and they themselves shall accept their lawlessnesses, because they overlooked my judgments and their soul was disgusted with my commands.

44 And not even thus, while they are in the land of their enemies, did I overlook them or become disgusted with them so as to utterly consume them, to scatter my covenant with them, because I am the Lord their God.

45 And I shall remember for them the former covenant, when I brought them out from the land of Egypt, from the house of slavery, before the nations, to be their God; I am the Lord.

46 These are the judgments and the commands and the law that the Lord gave between himself and between the sons of Israel on Mount Sina by the hand of Moses.

Chapter 27

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: Whoever vows a vow so that there is a valuation of his soul to the Lord,

3 the valuation of a male from twenty years old to sixty years old shall be fifty didrachms of silver by the holy weight.

4 And the assessment of a female shall be thirty didrachms.

5 But if from five years old to twenty years, the valuation of a male shall be twenty didrachms and of a female ten didrachms.

6 And from a month old to five years old, the valuation of a male shall be five didrachms of silver and of a female three didrachms.

7 But if from sixty years and above, if it is a male, the valuation shall be fifteen didrachms of silver, but if a female, ten didrachms.

8 But if he is too poor for the valuation, he shall stand before the priest, and the priest shall value him; according as the hand of the one who vowed has strength, the priest shall value him.

9 But if it is from the animals from which a gift is offered to the Lord, whatever one gives from these to the Lord shall be holy.

10 He shall not exchange it, good for bad or bad for good; but if, with exchanging, he exchanges an animal for an animal, both it and the exchange shall be holy.

11 But if it is any unclean animal from which a gift is not offered to the Lord, then he shall stand the animal before the priest,

12 and the priest shall value it between good and bad, and according as the priest values it, so it shall stand.

13 But if, with redeeming, he redeems it, he shall add the fifth to its valuation.

14 And a person who sanctifies his house as holy to the Lord, the priest shall value it between good and bad; as the priest values it, so it shall stand.

15 But if the one who sanctified it redeems his house, he shall add to it the fifth of the silver of its valuation, and it shall be his.

16 But if a person sanctifies to the Lord some of the field of his possession, then the valuation shall be according to its seed: for a kor of barley, fifty didrachms of silver.

17 But if he sanctifies his field from the year of the release, it shall stand according to its valuation.

18 But if he sanctifies his field later after the release, the priest shall calculate the silver for him according to the years remaining until the year of the release, and it shall be deducted from his assessment.

19 But if the one who sanctified the field redeems it, he shall add the fifth of the silver to its valuation, and it shall be his.

20 But if he does not redeem the field and sells the field to another person, he shall no longer redeem it.

21 Rather, when the release has gone out, the field shall be holy to the Lord, like the land that has been set apart; it shall be a possession for the priest.

22 But if he sanctifies to the Lord some of the field that he acquired, which is not from the field of his possession,

23 the priest shall calculate for him the completion of the valuation from the year of the release, and he shall repay the valuation on that day as holy to the Lord.

24 And in the year of the release the field shall be returned to the person from whom he acquired it, whose possession of the land it was.

25 And every valuation shall be by holy weights; the didrachm shall be twenty obols.

26 And every firstborn that arises among your animals shall belong to the Lord, and no one shall sanctify it; whether a calf or a sheep, it belongs to the Lord.

27 But if it is from the unclean quadrupeds, he shall exchange it according to its valuation and shall add the fifth to it, and it shall be his; but if he does not redeem it, it shall be sold according to its assessed value.

28 And every anathema that a person devotes to the Lord from all that belongs to him, from person to animal and from the field of his possession, shall not be sold or redeemed; every anathema shall be Holy of Holies to the Lord.

29 And anything from among people that is devoted shall not be redeemed, but by death it shall be put to death.

30 Every tenth of the land, from the seed of the land and the fruit of the tree, belongs to the Lord; it is holy to the Lord.

31 But if a person redeems his tenth with a ransom, he shall add the fifth to it, and it shall be his.

32 And every tenth of cattle and sheep, and everything that comes in the count under the rod, the tenth shall be holy to the Lord.

33 You shall not exchange good for bad; but if, with exchanging, you exchange it, then its exchange also shall be holy; it shall not be redeemed.

34 These are the commandments that the Lord commanded Moses for the sons of Israel on Mount Sina.

Numbers

Chapter 1

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sina, in the tabernacle of testimony, on the first of the second month of the second year after they had gone out from the land of Egypt, saying:

2 Take the head-count of the whole congregation of the sons of Israel according to their kinships, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number from their names, head by head, every male

3 from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force of Israel; muster them with their force; you and Aaron shall muster them.

4 And with you there shall be one from each tribe, from the rulers of each; they shall be according to the houses of their paternal families.

5 And these are the names of the men who shall stand with you: from Reuben, Elisour son of Sediour;

6 from Symeon, Salamiel son of Sourisadai;

7 from Judas, Naasson son of Aminadab;

8 from Issachar, Nathanael son of Sogar;

9 from Zaboulon, Eliab son of Chailon;

10 from the sons of Joseph: from Ephraim, Elisama son of Emioud; from Manasse, Gamaliel son of Phadassour;

11 from Benjamin, Abidan son of Gadeoni;

12 from Dan, Achiezer son of Amisadai;

13 from Aser, Phagaiel son of Echran;

14 from Gad, Elisaph son of Ragouel;

15 from Nephthali, Achire son of Ainan.

16 These are those called from the congregation, rulers of the tribes according to paternal families; they are commanders of thousands of Israel.

17 And Moses and Aaron took these men who had been called by name,

18 and they assembled the whole congregation on the first of the second month of the year, and they were enrolled according to their generations, according to their paternal families, according to the number of their names, from twenty years old and above, every male, head by head,

19 in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses; and they were mustered in the wilderness of Sina.

20 And the sons of Reuben, the firstborn of Israel, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

21 their muster from the tribe of Reuben was forty-six thousand five hundred. –

22 For the sons of Symeon, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

23 their muster from the tribe of Symeon was fifty-nine thousand three hundred. –

24 For the sons of Judas, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

25 their muster from the tribe of Judas was seventy-four thousand six hundred. –

26 For the sons of Issachar, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

27 their muster from the tribe of Issachar was fifty-four thousand four hundred. –

28 For the sons of Zaboulon, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

29 their muster from the tribe of Zaboulon was fifty-seven thousand four hundred. –

30 For the sons of Joseph, the sons of Ephraim, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

31 their muster from the tribe of Ephraim was forty thousand five hundred. –

32 For the sons of Manasse, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

33 their muster from the tribe of Manasse was thirty-two thousand two hundred. –

34 For the sons of Benjamin, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

35 their muster from the tribe of Benjamin was thirty-five thousand four hundred. –

36 For the sons of Gad, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

37 their muster from the tribe of Gad was forty-five thousand six hundred fifty. –

38 For the sons of Dan, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

39 their muster from the tribe of Dan was sixty-two thousand seven hundred. –

40 For the sons of Aser, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

41 their muster from the tribe of Aser was forty-one thousand five hundred. –

42 For the sons of Nephthali, according to their kinships, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to the number of their names, head by head, all males from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out in the force,

43 their muster from the tribe of Nephthali was fifty-three thousand four hundred. –

44 This is the muster that Moses and Aaron and the rulers of Israel mustered, twelve men; there was one man according to each one tribe, according to the tribe of the houses of the paternal family.

45 And the whole muster of the sons of Israel with their force, from twenty years old and above, everyone who goes out to be arrayed for battle in Israel, was

46 six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty.

47 But the Levites from the tribe of their paternal family were not mustered among the sons of Israel.

48 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

49 See that you do not also muster the tribe of Levi and do not take their number in the midst of the sons of Israel.

50 And you, appoint the Levites over the tabernacle of testimony and over all its vessels and over all the things that are in it; they shall carry the tabernacle and all its vessels, and they shall minister in it and shall encamp around the tabernacle.

51 And when the tabernacle moves, the Levites shall take it down, and when the tabernacle encamps, they shall raise it up; and let the foreigner who approaches die.

52 And the sons of Israel shall encamp, each man in his own order and each man according to his own leadership with their force.

53 But let the Levites encamp before the Lord around the tabernacle of testimony, and there shall be no sin among the sons of Israel. And the Levites themselves shall keep the watch of the tabernacle of testimony.

54 And the sons of Israel did according to all that the Lord commanded Moses and Aaron; thus they did.

Chapter 2

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 Let the sons of Israel encamp, each man next to him by order, by standards, according to the houses of their paternal families; opposite, around the tabernacle of testimony, the sons of Israel shall encamp.

3 And those encamping first toward the east shall be the order of the camp of Judas with their force, and the ruler of the sons of Judas shall be Naasson son of Aminadab.

4 His force, those mustered, was seventy-four thousand six hundred.

5 And those encamping next shall be of the tribe of Issachar, and the ruler of the sons of Issachar shall be Nathanael son of Sogar.

6 His force, those mustered, was fifty-four thousand four hundred.

7 And those encamping next shall be of the tribe of Zaboulon, and the ruler of the sons of Zaboulon shall be Eliab son of Chailon.

8 His force, those mustered, was fifty-seven thousand four hundred.

9 All those mustered from the camp of Judas were one hundred eighty-six thousand four hundred with their force; they shall set out first.

10 The order of the camp of Reuben toward the southwest with their force, and the ruler of the sons of Reuben shall be Elisour son of Sediour.

11 His force, those mustered, was forty-six thousand five hundred.

12 And those encamping next to him shall be of the tribe of Symeon, and the ruler of the sons of Symeon shall be Salamiel son of Sourisadai.

13 His force, those mustered, was fifty-nine thousand three hundred.

14 And those encamping next to him shall be of the tribe of Gad, and the ruler of the sons of Gad shall be Elisaph son of Ragouel.

15 His force, those mustered, was forty-five thousand six hundred fifty.

16 All those mustered from the camp of Reuben were one hundred fifty-one thousand four hundred fifty with their force; they shall set out second. –

17 And the tabernacle of testimony and the camp of the Levites shall be taken up in the midst of the camps; as they encamp, so also shall they set out, each one next to the other according to leadership.

18 The order of the camp of Ephraim by the sea with their force, and the ruler of the sons of Ephraim shall be Elisama son of Emioud.

19 His force, those mustered, was forty thousand five hundred.

20 And those encamping next shall be of the tribe of Manasse, and the ruler of the sons of Manasse shall be Gamaliel son of Phadassour.

21 His force, those mustered, was thirty-two thousand two hundred.

22 And those encamping next shall be of the tribe of Benjamin, and the ruler of the sons of Benjamin shall be Abidan son of Gadeoni.

23 His force, those mustered, was thirty-five thousand four hundred.

24 All those mustered from the camp of Ephraim were one hundred eight thousand one hundred with their force; they shall set out third.

25 The order of the camp of Dan toward the north with their force, and the ruler of the sons of Dan shall be Achiezer son of Amisadai.

26 His force, those mustered, was sixty-two thousand seven hundred.

27 And those encamping next to him shall be of the tribe of Aser, and the ruler of the sons of Aser shall be Phagaiel son of Echran.

28 His force, those mustered, was forty-one thousand five hundred.

29 And those encamping next shall be of the tribe of Nephthali, and the ruler of the sons of Nephthali shall be Achire son of Ainan.

30 His force, those mustered, was fifty-three thousand four hundred.

31 All those mustered from the camp of Dan were one hundred fifty-seven thousand six hundred; they shall set out last according to their order.

32 This is the muster of the sons of Israel according to the houses of their paternal families; the whole muster of the camps with their forces was six hundred three thousand five hundred fifty.

33 But the Levites were not mustered together among them, just as the Lord commanded Moses.

34 And the sons of Israel did all that the Lord instructed Moses; thus they encamped according to their order and thus they set out, each one next to the others according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families.

Chapter 3

1 And these are the generations of Aaron and Moses on the day on which the Lord spoke to Moses on Mount Sina.

2 And these are the names of the sons of Aaron: the firstborn Nadab, and Abioud, Eleazar, and Ithamar.

3 These are the names of the sons of Aaron, the anointed priests, whose hands they perfected to serve as priests.

4 And Nadab and Abioud died before the Lord when they offered strange fire before the Lord in the wilderness of Sina, and there were no children for them; and Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests with Aaron their father.

5 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

6 Take the tribe of Levi and stand them before Aaron the priest, and they shall minister to him.

7 And they shall keep his watches and the watches of the sons of Israel before the tabernacle of testimony, to perform the works of the tabernacle.

8 And they shall keep all the vessels of the tabernacle of testimony and the watches of the sons of Israel concerning all the works of the tabernacle.

9 And you shall give the Levites to Aaron and to his sons the priests; a gift, given, these are mine from the sons of Israel.

10 And you shall appoint Aaron and his sons over the tabernacle of testimony, and they shall keep their priesthood and all the things around the altar and inside the veil; and the foreigner who touches shall die.

11 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

12 And I, behold, have taken the Levites from the midst of the sons of Israel in place of every firstborn that opens the womb among the sons of Israel; they shall be their ransom, and the Levites shall be mine.

13 For every firstborn is mine; on the day on which I struck every firstborn in the land of Egypt, I sanctified to myself every firstborn in Israel, from person to animal; they shall be mine; I am the Lord.

14 And the Lord spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sina, saying:

15 Muster the sons of Levi according to the houses of their paternal families, according to their clans, according to their kinships; every male from a month old and above, you shall muster them.

16 And Moses and Aaron mustered them through the voice of the Lord, in the manner that the Lord instructed them.

17 And these were the sons of Levi by their names: Gedson, Kaath, and Merari.

18 And these are the names of the sons of Gedson according to their clans: Lobeni and Semei.

19 And the sons of Kaath according to their clans: Amram and Issaar, Chebron and Oziel.

20 And the sons of Merari according to their clans: Mooli and Mousi. These are the clans of the Levites according to the houses of their paternal families.

21 To Gedson belonged the clan of Lobeni and the clan of Semei; these are the clans of Gedson.

22 Their muster, according to the number of every male from a month old and above, their muster was seven thousand five hundred.

23 And the sons of Gedson shall encamp behind the tabernacle by the sea,

24 and the ruler of the house of the paternal family of the clan of Gedson shall be Elisaph son of Lael.

25 And the watch of the sons of Gedson in the tabernacle of testimony shall be the tabernacle and the covering and the covering of the door of the tabernacle of testimony,

26 and the curtains of the court and the veil of the gate of the court that is upon the tabernacle and the remaining things of all its works.

27 To Kaath belonged the clan of Amramis and the clan of Saaris and the clan of Chebronis and the clan of Ozielis; these are the clans of Kaath.

28 According to the number of every male from a month old and above, eight thousand six hundred, keeping the watches of the holy things.

29 The clans of the sons of Kaath shall encamp at the sides of the tabernacle toward the southwest,

30 and the ruler of the house of the paternal families of the clans of Kaath shall be Elisaphan son of Oziel.

31 And their watch shall be the ark and the table and the lampstand and the altars and the vessels of the holy place with which they minister and the covering and all their works.

32 And the ruler over the rulers of the Levites shall be Eleazar son of Aaron the priest, appointed to keep the watches of the holy things.

33 To Merari belonged the clan of Mooli and the clan of Mousi; these are the clans of Merari.

34 Their muster according to number, every male from a month old and above, was six thousand fifty.

35 And the ruler of the house of the paternal families of the clan of Merari shall be Souriel son of Abichail; they shall encamp at the sides of the tabernacle toward the north.

36 The muster, the watch of the sons of Merari, shall be the capitals of the tabernacle and its bars and its pillars and its bases and all their vessels and their works,

37 and the pillars of the court all around and their bases and the stakes and their cords.

38 And those encamping before the tabernacle of testimony toward the east shall be Moses and Aaron and his sons, keeping the watches of the holy place for the watches of the sons of Israel; and the foreigner who touches shall die.

39 The whole muster of the Levites whom Moses and Aaron mustered through the voice of the Lord according to their clans, every male from a month old and above, was twenty-two thousand.

40 And the Lord said to Moses, saying: Muster every male firstborn of the sons of Israel from a month old and above and take their number by name.

41 And you shall take the Levites for me—I am the Lord—in place of all the firstborn of the sons of Israel, and the animals of the Levites in place of all the firstborn among the animals of the sons of Israel.

42 And Moses mustered, in the manner that the Lord commanded, every firstborn among the sons of Israel.

43 And all the male firstborn, according to the number by name, from a month old and above, from their muster, were twenty-two thousand two hundred seventy-three.

44 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

45 Take the Levites in place of all the firstborn of the sons of Israel and the animals of the Levites in place of their animals, and the Levites shall be mine; I am the Lord.

46 And as the ransom of the two hundred seventy-three who exceed the Levites from among the firstborn of the sons of Israel,

47 you shall take five shekels per head; according to the holy didrachm you shall take them, twenty obols to the shekel.

48 And you shall give the silver to Aaron and his sons as the ransom of those who exceed among them.

49 And Moses took the silver, the ransom of those who exceeded, for the redemption from the Levites.

50 From the firstborn of the sons of Israel he took the silver, one thousand three hundred sixty-five shekels according to the holy shekel.

51 And Moses gave the ransom of those who exceeded to Aaron and his sons through the voice of the Lord, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses.

Chapter 4

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 Take the head-count of the sons of Kaath from the midst of the sons of Levi according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families,

3 from twenty-five years old and above and up to fifty years old, everyone who enters to minister, to perform all the works in the tabernacle of testimony.

4 And these are the works of the sons of Kaath in the tabernacle of testimony: the Holy of Holies.

5 And Aaron and his sons shall enter when the camp sets out, and they shall take down the overshadowing veil and shall cover the ark of testimony with it.

6 And they shall place upon it a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall throw over it a cloth entirely hyacinth-colored above and shall insert the carrying poles.

7 And upon the table set forth they shall throw a cloth entirely purple and the dishes and the censers and the cups and the libation vessels with which he pours libations, and the continual loaves shall be upon it.

8 And they shall throw a scarlet cloth over it and cover it with a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall insert the carrying poles through it.

9 And they shall take a hyacinth-colored cloth and cover the lampstand that gives light and its lamps and its tongs and its oil-drawers and all the vessels of oil with which they minister,

10 and they shall put it and all its vessels into a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall place it upon carrying poles.

11 And over the golden altar they shall cover a hyacinth-colored cloth and shall cover it with a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall insert its carrying poles.

12 And they shall take all the ministering vessels with which they minister in the holy things and shall put them into a hyacinth-colored cloth and cover them with a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall place them upon carrying poles.

13 And he shall place the cover upon the altar, and they shall cover it over with a cloth entirely purple.

14 And they shall place upon it all the vessels with which they minister upon it, both the fire-pans and the flesh-hooks and the bowls and the cover and all the vessels of the altar; and they shall throw over it a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and shall insert its carrying poles; and they shall take a purple cloth and cover together the laver and its base and put them into a covering of hyacinth-colored skin and place them upon carrying poles.

15 And Aaron and his sons shall finish covering the holy things and all the holy vessels when the camp sets out, and after these things the sons of Kaath shall enter to carry them, but they shall not touch the holy things, so that they do not die; these things the sons of Kaath shall carry in the tabernacle of testimony. –

16 The overseer shall be Eleazar son of Aaron the priest: the oil of the light and the compounded incense and the daily sacrifice and the oil of anointing, the oversight of the whole tabernacle and all that is in it, in the holy place, in all the works. –

17 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

18 Do not utterly destroy the clan of Kaath from the midst of the Levites.

19 Do this for them, and they shall live and certainly shall not die when they approach the Holy of Holies: let Aaron and his sons approach and appoint them, each one according to his load.

20 And they shall certainly not enter to see the holy things suddenly, and they will die.

21 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

22 Take the head-count of the sons of Gedson, these also, according to the houses of their paternal families, according to their clans.

23 From twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, muster them, everyone who enters to minister and to perform his works in the tabernacle of testimony.

24 This is the ministry of the clan of Gedson, to minister and to carry:

25 and he shall carry the skins of the tabernacle and the tabernacle of testimony and its covering and the hyacinth-colored covering that is upon it above and the covering of the door of the tabernacle of testimony,

26 and the curtains of the court, as many as are upon the tabernacle of testimony, and the excesses and all the ministering vessels with which they minister; they shall perform these things.

27 According to the mouth of Aaron and his sons shall be the ministry of the sons of Gedson, according to all their ministries and according to all the things carried by them; and you shall muster them by name for all the things carried by them.

28 This is the ministry of the sons of Gedson in the tabernacle of testimony, and their watch shall be in the hand of Ithamar son of Aaron the priest.

29 The sons of Merari, according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, you shall muster them.

30 From twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, you shall muster them, everyone who enters to minister in the works of the tabernacle of testimony.

31 And these are the observances of the things carried by them, according to all their works in the tabernacle of testimony: the capitals of the tabernacle and the bars and its pillars and its bases and the covering and their bases and their pillars and the covering of the door of the tabernacle,

32 and the pillars of the court all around and their bases and the pillars of the veil of the gate of the court and their bases and their stakes and their cords and all their vessels and all their ministries; you shall muster them by name for all the vessels of the watch of the things carried by them.

33 This is the ministry of the clan of the sons of Merari in all their works in the tabernacle of testimony, in the hand of Ithamar son of Aaron the priest.

34 And Moses and Aaron and the rulers of Israel mustered the sons of Kaath according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families,

35 from twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, everyone who enters to minister and to work in the tabernacle of testimony.

36 And their muster according to their clans was two thousand two hundred fifty.

37 This is the muster of the clan of Kaath, everyone who ministers in the tabernacle of testimony, as Moses and Aaron mustered them through the voice of the Lord by the hand of Moses.

38 And the sons of Gedson were mustered according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families,

39 from twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, everyone who enters to minister and to perform the works in the tabernacle of testimony.

40 And their muster according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, was two thousand six hundred thirty.

41 This is the muster of the clan of the sons of Gedson, everyone who ministers in the tabernacle of testimony, whom Moses and Aaron mustered through the voice of the Lord by the hand of Moses.

42 And the clan of the sons of Merari also was mustered according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families,

43 from twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, everyone who enters to minister at the works of the tabernacle of testimony.

44 And their muster according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families, was three thousand two hundred.

45 This is the muster of the clan of the sons of Merari, whom Moses and Aaron mustered through the voice of the Lord by the hand of Moses.

46 All those mustered, whom Moses and Aaron and the rulers of Israel mustered, the Levites according to their clans, according to the houses of their paternal families,

47 from twenty-five years old and above up to fifty years old, everyone who enters for the work of the works and for the works that are carried in the tabernacle of testimony,

48 and those mustered were eight thousand five hundred eighty.

49 Through the voice of the Lord he mustered them by the hand of Moses, man by man over their works and over the things that they themselves carry; and they were mustered in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses.

Chapter 5

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Command the sons of Israel, and let them send out from the camp every leprous person and everyone with a seminal discharge and everyone unclean by a soul.

3 From male to female, send them outside the camp, and they shall certainly not defile their camps, in which I dwell among them.

4 And the sons of Israel did thus and sent them outside the camp; just as the Lord spoke to Moses, thus the sons of Israel did.

5 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

6 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: A man or woman, whoever does any of the human sins and, with overlooking, overlooks and that soul trespasses,

7 shall declare the sin that he committed and shall repay the trespass, the principal, and shall add its fifth to it and repay it to the one against whom he trespassed.

8 But if the person has no kinsman so as to repay the trespass to him, the trespass repaid to the Lord shall belong to the priest, apart from the ram of propitiation through which he shall make atonement with it concerning him.

9 And every firstfruit, according to all the things sanctified among the sons of Israel, as many as they offer to the Lord, shall belong to the priest himself.

10 And each person’s sanctified things shall be his; whatever a man gives to the priest shall belong to him.

11 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

12 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: If the wife of any man transgresses and, with overlooking, overlooks him,

13 and someone lies with her with an emission of semen and it escapes the eyes of her husband and she conceals it, and she is defiled and there was no witness with her and she was not caught,

14 and a spirit of jealousy comes upon him and he is jealous of his wife, and she has been defiled; or a spirit of jealousy comes upon him and he is jealous of his wife, but she has not been defiled,

15 then the man shall bring his wife to the priest and shall offer the gift concerning her, a tenth of an oiphi of barley flour; he shall not pour oil upon it or place frankincense upon it, for it is a sacrifice of jealousy, a sacrifice of memorial that brings sin to remembrance.

16 And the priest shall bring her near and shall stand her before the Lord.

17 And the priest shall take pure living water in an earthen vessel and some of the earth that is upon the floor of the tabernacle of testimony, and the priest, taking it, shall put it into the water.

18 And the priest shall stand the woman before the Lord and shall uncover the woman’s head and shall put into her hands the sacrifice of memorial, the sacrifice of jealousy, but in the priest’s hand shall be the water of reproof, this cursed water.

19 And the priest shall put her under oath and shall say to the woman: If no one has lain with you, if you have not transgressed to be defiled while under your own husband, be guiltless from the water of reproof, this cursed water.

20 But if you have transgressed while being under a husband, or have been defiled and someone has given his bed in you besides your husband—

21 then the priest shall put the woman under oath with the oaths of this curse, and the priest shall say to the woman: May the Lord give you for a curse and a thing sworn in the midst of your people, when the Lord gives your thigh fallen and your belly swollen,

22 and this cursed water shall enter into your belly, to swell the stomach and cause your thigh to fall. And the woman shall say: May it be, may it be.

23 And the priest shall write these curses in a book and shall wipe them into the water of reproof, the cursed water.

24 And he shall make the woman drink the water of reproof, the cursed water, and the cursed water of reproof shall enter into her.

25 And the priest shall take the sacrifice of jealousy from the woman’s hand and shall present the sacrifice before the Lord and shall bring it to the altar.

26 And the priest shall grasp from the sacrifice its memorial portion and shall offer it upon the altar, and after these things he shall make the woman drink the water.

27 And it shall be, if she has been defiled and, with escaping notice, escapes the notice of her husband, then the water of reproof, the cursed water, shall enter into her, and her belly shall swell and her thigh shall fall, and the woman shall become a curse among her people.

28 But if the woman was not defiled and is clean, then she shall be guiltless and shall produce seed. –

29 This is the law of jealousy, when a woman transgresses while being under a husband and is defiled,

30 or when a spirit of jealousy comes upon a person and he is jealous of his wife; then he shall stand his wife before the Lord, and the priest shall perform for her all this law.

31 And the man shall be guiltless from sin, and that woman shall bear her sin.

Chapter 6

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: A man or woman who greatly vows a vow to purify a purification to the Lord

3 shall be purified from wine and sikera; he shall not drink vinegar from wine or vinegar from sikera, and he shall not drink anything produced from grapes, and he shall not eat fresh grapes or raisins.

4 All the days of his vow he shall not eat anything that comes from the vine, from pressed grape skins to grape-seed.

5 All the days of the vow of purification, a razor shall not come upon his head; until the days that he vowed to the Lord are fulfilled, he shall be holy, growing the hair of his head long.

6 All the days of the vow to the Lord he shall not enter upon any soul that has died.

7 By father and by mother and by brother and by sister, he shall not be defiled by them when they have died, because the vow of his God is upon him, upon his head.

8 All the days of his vow he shall be holy to the Lord. –

9 But if someone dies suddenly beside him, immediately the head of his vow shall be defiled, and he shall shave his head on whatever day he is cleansed; on the seventh day he shall be shaved.

10 And on the eighth day he shall bring two turtledoves or two young pigeons to the priest at the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

11 And the priest shall make one concerning sin and one as a whole burnt offering, and the priest shall make atonement concerning him for the things in which he sinned concerning the soul, and he shall sanctify his head on that day,

12 on which he was sanctified to the Lord for the days of the vow, and he shall bring a year-old lamb for trespass; and the former days shall be unreckoned, because the head of his vow was defiled.

13 And this is the law of the one who vowed: on whatever day he fulfills the days of his vow, he himself shall bring it beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony.

14 And he shall bring his gift to the Lord: one year-old unblemished lamb as a whole burnt offering and one year-old unblemished ewe lamb concerning sin and one unblemished ram as a salvation,

15 and a basket of unleavened things of fine flour, loaves worked up in oil and unleavened flat cakes anointed with oil, and their sacrifice and their libation.

16 And the priest shall offer them before the Lord and shall make his thing concerning sin and his whole burnt offering.

17 And he shall make the ram a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord with the basket of unleavened things, and the priest shall make his sacrifice and his libation.

18 And the one who vowed shall shave the head of his vow beside the doors of the tabernacle of testimony and shall place the hairs upon the fire that is under the sacrifice of salvation.

19 And the priest shall take the boiled arm from the ram and one unleavened loaf from the basket and one unleavened flat cake and shall place them upon the hands of the one who vowed after he has shaved his vow.

20 And the priest shall offer them as a presentation before the Lord; it shall be holy for the priest in addition to the breast of presentation and in addition to the arm of the removal offering; and after these things the one who vowed shall drink wine. –

21 This is the law of the one who vowed, whoever vows to the Lord his gift to the Lord concerning the vow, apart from whatever his hand finds according to the ability of his vow that he vows, according to the law of purification.

22 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

23 Speak to Aaron and to his sons, saying: Thus you shall bless the sons of Israel, saying to them: [and they shall place my name upon the sons of Israel, and I the Lord shall bless them]

24 May the Lord bless you and keep you;

25 may the Lord make his face appear upon you and have mercy on you;

26 may the Lord lift up his face upon you and give you peace.

Chapter 7

1 And it happened on the day when Moses finished erecting the tabernacle, that he anointed it and sanctified it and all its vessels and the altar and all its vessels, and he anointed them and sanctified them,

2 and the rulers of Israel presented, twelve rulers of the houses of their paternal families—these were rulers of tribes, these were the ones who stood over the muster—

3 and they brought their gifts before the Lord: six covered wagons and twelve oxen, a wagon from every two rulers and a calf from each, and they brought them before the tent.

4 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

5 Take them from them, and they shall be for the ministerial works of the tent of testimony, and you shall give them to the Levites, to each according to his ministry.

6 And Moses took the wagons and the oxen and gave them to the Levites;

7 the two wagons and the four oxen he gave to the sons of Gedson according to their ministries,

8 and the four wagons and the eight oxen he gave to the sons of Merari according to their ministries through Ithamar son of Aaron the priest.

9 But to the sons of Kaath he gave none, because they have the ministries of the sanctuary; they shall carry them upon shoulders.

10 And the rulers presented offerings for the inauguration of the altar on the day when he anointed it, and the rulers presented their gifts before the altar.

11 And the Lord said to Moses: One ruler per day, one ruler per day, shall present their gifts for the inauguration of the altar.

12 And the one presenting his gift on the first day was Naasson son of Aminadab, ruler of the tribe of Judas.

13 And he presented his gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

14 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

15 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

16 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

17 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Naasson son of Aminadab.

18 On the second day Nathanael son of Sogar, ruler of the tribe of Issachar, presented.

19 And he presented his gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

20 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

21 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

22 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

23 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Nathanael son of Sogar.

24 On the third day, the ruler of the sons of Zaboulon, Eliab son of Chailon.

25 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

26 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

27 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

28 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

29 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Eliab son of Chailon.

30 On the fourth day, the ruler of the sons of Reuben, Elisour son of Sediour.

31 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

32 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

33 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

34 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

35 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Elisour son of Sediour.

36 On the fifth day, the ruler of the sons of Symeon, Salamiel son of Sourisadai.

37 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

38 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

39 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

40 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

41 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Salamiel son of Sourisadai.

42 On the sixth day, the ruler of the sons of Gad, Elisaph son of Ragouel.

43 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

44 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

45 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

46 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

47 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Elisaph son of Ragouel.

48 On the seventh day, the ruler of the sons of Ephraim, Elisama son of Emioud.

49 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

50 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

51 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

52 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

53 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Elisama son of Emioud.

54 On the eighth day, the ruler of the sons of Manasse, Gamaliel son of Phadassour.

55 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

56 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

57 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

58 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

59 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Gamaliel son of Phadassour.

60 On the ninth day, the ruler of the sons of Benjamin, Abidan son of Gadeoni.

61 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

62 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

63 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

64 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

65 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Abidan son of Gadeoni.

66 On the tenth day, the ruler of the sons of Dan, Achiezer son of Amisadai.

67 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

68 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

69 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

70 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

71 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Achiezer son of Amisadai.

72 On the eleventh day, the ruler of the sons of Aser, Phagaiel son of Echran.

73 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

74 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

75 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

76 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

77 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Phagaiel son of Echran.

78 On the twelfth day, the ruler of the sons of Nephthali, Achire son of Ainan.

79 His gift: one silver dish, one hundred thirty its weight; one silver bowl of seventy shekels according to the holy shekel; both full of fine flour worked with oil, for a sacrifice;

80 one censer of ten gold pieces, full of incense;

81 one calf from cattle, one ram, one year-old lamb for a whole burnt offering;

82 and one male kid from goats concerning sin;

83 and for a sacrifice of salvation, two heifers, five rams, five male goats, five year-old ewe lambs. This was the gift of Achire son of Ainan.

84 This was the inauguration of the altar, on the day when he anointed it, from the rulers of the sons of Israel: twelve silver dishes, twelve silver bowls, twelve gold censers;

85 the one dish was one hundred thirty shekels and the one bowl seventy shekels; all the silver of the vessels was two thousand four hundred shekels according to the holy shekel.

86 Twelve gold censers full of incense; all the gold of the censers was one hundred twenty gold pieces.

87 All the cattle for the whole burnt offering: twelve calves, twelve rams, twelve year-old lambs, and their sacrifices and their libations; and twelve male kids from goats concerning sin.

88 All the cattle for a sacrifice of salvation: twenty-four heifers, sixty rams, sixty male goats, sixty unblemished year-old ewe lambs. This was the inauguration of the altar after filling its hands and after anointing it. –

89 When Moses entered the tent of testimony to speak to him, he also heard the voice of the Lord speaking to him from above the propitiatory that is upon the ark of testimony, between the two cherubim; and he spoke to him.

Chapter 8

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to Aaron, and you shall say to him: Whenever you set the lamps, from the side facing the lampstand the seven lamps shall give light.

3 And Aaron did so; from the one side facing the lampstand he lit its lamps, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses.

4 And this was the construction of the lampstand: solid gold, its shaft and its lilies, entirely solid; according to the form that the Lord showed Moses, so he made the lampstand.

5 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

6 Take the Levites from the midst of the sons of Israel and purify them.

7 And thus you shall perform their purification for them: you shall sprinkle water of purification all around them, and a razor shall pass over all their body, and they shall wash their garments and shall be clean.

8 And they shall take one calf from cattle and its sacrifice of fine flour worked with oil, and you shall take a year-old calf from cattle concerning sin.

9 And you shall bring the Levites before the tent of testimony and shall gather the entire congregation of the sons of Israel.

10 And you shall bring the Levites before the Lord, and the sons of Israel shall place their hands upon the Levites,

11 and Aaron shall set apart the Levites as a return-gift before the Lord from the sons of Israel, and they shall be for performing the works of the Lord.

12 And the Levites shall place their hands upon the heads of the calves, and he shall make the one concerning sin and the one as a whole burnt offering to the Lord, to make atonement concerning them.

13 And you shall stand the Levites before the Lord and before Aaron and before his sons, and you shall give them back as a return-gift before the Lord;

14 and you shall distinguish the Levites from the midst of the sons of Israel, and they shall be mine.

15 And after these things the Levites shall enter to perform the works of the tent of testimony, and you shall cleanse them and give them back before the Lord.

16 For these have been given back to me as a return-gift from the midst of the sons of Israel; in place of those opening every womb, all the firstborn from the sons of Israel, I have taken them for myself.

17 For every firstborn among the sons of Israel is mine, from human to livestock; on the day when I struck every firstborn in the land of Egypt, I sanctified them to myself,

18 and I took the Levites in place of every firstborn among the sons of Israel.

19 And I have given back the Levites, given as a return-gift to Aaron and his sons from the midst of the sons of Israel, to perform the works of the sons of Israel in the tent of testimony and to make atonement concerning the sons of Israel, and there shall be no one among the sons of Israel approaching the holy things. –

20 And Moses and Aaron and the entire congregation of the sons of Israel did to the Levites in the manner that the Lord commanded Moses concerning the Levites; thus the sons of Israel did to them.

21 And the Levites purified themselves and washed their garments, and Aaron gave them back as a return-gift before the Lord, and Aaron made atonement concerning them, to purify them.

22 And after these things the Levites entered to minister their ministry in the tent of testimony before Aaron and before his sons; just as the Lord instructed Moses concerning the Levites, so they did to them.

23 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

24 This is the matter concerning the Levites: from twenty-five years old and above they shall enter to be active in the tent of testimony;

25 and from fifty years old he shall withdraw from the ministry and shall no longer work,

26 and his brother shall minister in the tent of testimony to keep watches, but he shall not perform works. Thus you shall do to the Levites in their watches.

Chapter 9

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sina in the second year after they went out from the land of Egypt, in the first month, saying:

2 Say, and let the sons of Israel perform the Passover at its appointed time;

3 on the fourteenth day of the first month toward evening you shall perform it according to appointed times; according to its law and according to its comparison you shall perform it.

4 And Moses spoke to the sons of Israel to perform the Passover.

5 When it was beginning on the fourteenth day of the month in the wilderness of Sina, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses, so the sons of Israel did.

6 And the men arrived who were unclean on account of a human soul and were unable to perform the Passover on that day, and they came before Moses and Aaron on that day,

7 and those men said to him: We are unclean on account of a human soul; shall we then fail to present the gift to the Lord at its appointed time in the midst of the sons of Israel?

8 And Moses said to them: Stand there, and I will hear what the Lord will command concerning you. –

9 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

10 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: Person by person, whoever becomes unclean on account of a human soul or is on a journey far away, among you or among your generations, shall also perform the Passover to the Lord;

11 in the second month, on the fourteenth day, toward evening they shall perform it; with unleavened bread and bitter herbs they shall eat it.

12 They shall leave none of it until morning, and they shall not break a bone from it; according to the law of the Passover they shall perform it.

13 And a person who is clean and is not on a distant journey and fails to perform the Passover—that soul shall be utterly destroyed from its people; because he did not present the gift to the Lord at its appointed time, that person shall receive his sin. –

14 And if a proselyte comes to you in your land and performs the Passover to the Lord, according to the law of the Passover and according to its ordinance he shall perform it; there shall be one law for you and for the proselyte and for the native of the land.

15 And on the day when the tent was set up, the cloud covered the tent, the house of testimony; and in the evening it was upon the tent like the appearance of fire until morning.

16 Thus it happened continually; the cloud covered it by day and the appearance of fire by night.

17 And whenever the cloud rose from the tent, after these things the sons of Israel set out; and at the place where the cloud stood, there the sons of Israel encamped.

18 By the command of the Lord the sons of Israel shall encamp, and by the command of the Lord they shall set out; all the days in which the cloud overshadows the tent, the sons of Israel shall encamp;

19 and whenever the cloud remains over the tent for more days, the sons of Israel shall also keep the watch of God and shall certainly not set out;

20 and it shall be, whenever the cloud covers the tent for a number of days, by the voice of the Lord they shall encamp and by the command of the Lord they shall set out;

21 and it shall be, whenever the cloud remains from evening until morning and the cloud rises in the morning, then they shall set out by day or by night;

22 for a month of days, while the cloud continues overshadowing it, the sons of Israel shall encamp and shall certainly not set out.

23 For by the command of the Lord they shall set out; they kept the watch of the Lord by the command of the Lord through the hand of Moses.

Chapter 10

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Make for yourself two silver trumpets; you shall make them hammered, and they shall be for you for calling together the congregation and making the camps set out.

3 And you shall sound them, and the entire congregation shall be gathered at the door of the tent of testimony;

4 but if they sound with one, all the rulers, the leaders of Israel, shall come to you.

5 And you shall sound a signal, and the camps encamping toward the east shall set out;

6 and you shall sound a second signal, and the camps encamping toward the southwest shall set out; and you shall sound a third signal, and the camps encamping by the sea shall set out; and you shall sound a fourth signal, and the camps encamping toward the north shall set out; they shall sound with a signal at their setting out.

7 And whenever you gather the congregation, you shall sound, but not with a signal.

8 And the sons of Aaron, the priests, shall sound the trumpets, and it shall be an eternal ordinance for you throughout your generations.

9 And if you go out to war in your land against the adversaries who oppose you, then you shall signal with the trumpets and shall be remembered before the Lord and shall be delivered from your enemies.

10 And on the days of your rejoicing and at your festivals and at your new moons you shall sound the trumpets over the whole burnt offerings and over the sacrifices of your salvation, and it shall be a remembrance for you before your God; I am the Lord your God.

11 And it happened in the second year, in the second month, on the twentieth of the month, that the cloud rose from the tent of testimony,

12 and the sons of Israel set out with their equipment in the wilderness of Sina, and the cloud stood in the wilderness of Pharan.

13 And they set out first by the voice of the Lord through the hand of Moses. –

14 And the order of the camp of the sons of Judas set out first with their force; and over their force was Naasson son of Aminadab,

15 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Issachar was Nathanael son of Sogar,

16 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Zaboulon was Eliab son of Chailon.

17 And they shall take down the tent, and the sons of Gedson and the sons of Merari shall set out carrying the tent. –

18 And the order of the camp of Reuben set out with their force; and over their force was Elisour son of Sediour,

19 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Symeon was Salamiel son of Sourisadai,

20 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Gad was Elisaph, the one of Ragouel.

21 And the sons of Kaath shall set out carrying the holy things, and they shall set up the tent until they arrive. –

22 And the order of the camp of Ephraim shall set out with their force; and over their force was Elisama son of Emioud,

23 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Manasse was Gamaliel, the one of Phadassour,

24 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Benjamin was Abidan, the one of Gadeoni. –

25 And the order of the camp of the sons of Dan shall set out last of all the camps with their force; and over their force was Achiezer, the one of Amisadai,

26 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Aser was Phagaiel son of Echran,

27 and over the force of the tribe of the sons of Nephthali was Achire son of Ainan.

28 These were the armies of the sons of Israel, and they set out with their force.

29 And Moses said to Jobab son of Ragouel the Midianite, Moses's in-law: We are setting out for the place of which the Lord said, This I will give you. Come with us, and we will do you good, because the Lord has spoken good things concerning Israel.

30 And he said to him: I will not go, but to my land and to my generation.

31 And he said: Do not abandon us, since you were with us in the wilderness, and you shall be an elder among us;

32 and it shall be, if you go with us, and those good things shall be, as many as the Lord may do good to us, and we will do good to you.

33 And they set out from the mountain of the Lord on a journey of three days, and the ark of the covenant of the Lord went ahead of them on a journey of three days to scout out rest for them.

34 And it happened when the ark set out that Moses said: Rise up, Lord; let your enemies be scattered; let all who hate you flee.

35 And when it rested he said: Turn back, Lord, thousands of myriads in Israel.

36 And the cloud was overshadowing them by day when they set out from the camp.

Chapter 11

1 And the people were murmuring evil things before the Lord, and the Lord heard and was enraged with wrath, and fire from the Lord was kindled among them and devoured a certain part of the camp.

2 And the people cried out to Moses, and Moses prayed to the Lord, and the fire abated.

3 And the name of that place was called Burning, because fire from the Lord was kindled among them.

4 And the mixed multitude among them desired a desire, and the sons of Israel also sat down and wept and said: Who will feed us meat?

5 We remembered the fish that we ate freely in Egypt, and the cucumbers and the melons and the leeks and the onions and the garlic;

6 but now our soul is utterly dry; there is nothing except our eyes toward the manna.

7 And the manna is like coriander seed, and its appearance is the appearance of crystal;

8 and the people went about and gathered it and ground it in the mill and pounded it in the mortar and boiled it in the pot and made it into cakes baked in ashes, and its flavor was like the taste of a cake made with oil;

9 and whenever the dew descended upon the camp by night, the manna descended upon it.

10 And Moses heard them weeping according to their communities, each one at his door; and the Lord was exceedingly enraged with wrath, and it was evil before Moses.

11 And Moses said to the Lord: Why have you afflicted your attendant, and why have I not found favor before you, that you should place the onrush of this people upon me?

12 Did I conceive all this people in the womb, or did I bear them, that you say to me, Take him into your bosom, as a nurse might carry the nursing child, into the land that you swore to their fathers?

13 From where is there meat for me to give to all this people? For they weep against me, saying: Give us meat, that we may eat.

14 I shall not be able to bear this people alone, because this matter is heavier for me.

15 But if you deal thus with me, kill me by slaying me, if I have found mercy with you, so that I may not see my affliction. –

16 And the Lord said to Moses: Gather for me seventy men from the elders of Israel, whom you yourself know, that these are elders of the people and their scribes, and you shall bring them to the tent of testimony, and they shall stand there with you.

17 And I will descend and speak there with you, and I will take away from the spirit that is upon you and place it upon them, and they shall take hold together with you of the onrush of the people, and you shall not bear them alone.

18 And you shall say to the people: Purify yourselves for tomorrow, and you shall eat meat, because you wept before the Lord, saying: Who will feed us meat? Because it is good for us in Egypt. And the Lord will give you meat to eat, and you shall eat meat.

19 You shall eat not one day, nor two, nor five days, nor ten days, nor twenty days;

20 up to a month of days you shall eat, until it comes out from your nostrils, and it shall become cholera for you, because you disobeyed the Lord, who is among you, and wept before him, saying: Why did we come out of Egypt?

21 And Moses said: The people among whom I am are six hundred thousand on foot, and you said: I will give them meat to eat, and they shall eat for a month of days?

22 Surely sheep and cattle will not be slaughtered for them and suffice for them? Or will all the food of the sea be gathered for them and suffice for them?

23 And the Lord said to Moses: Will the hand of the Lord not be sufficient? Now you shall know whether my word will overtake you or not.

24 And Moses went out and spoke the words of the Lord to the people and gathered seventy men from the elders of the people and stood them around the tent.

25 And the Lord descended in a cloud and spoke to him; and he took from the spirit that was upon him and placed it upon the seventy men, the elders; and when the spirit rested upon them, they also prophesied and did not add any more.

26 And two men had been left behind in the camp, the name of the one Eldad and the name of the second Modad, and the spirit rested upon them – and these were among those enrolled and did not come to the tent – and they prophesied in the camp.

27 And the young man ran and reported to Moses and said: Eldad and Modad are prophesying in the camp.

28 And Jesus, the one of Nave, who stood beside Moses, the chosen one, answered and said: Lord Moses, prevent them.

29 And Moses said to him: Are you jealous for me? And who might give all the people of the Lord as prophets, whenever the Lord gives his spirit upon them?

30 And Moses went away into the camp, he and the elders of Israel. –

31 And a wind went out from the Lord and carried quail across from the sea and cast it over the camp, a day's journey on this side and a day's journey on that side, around the camp, about two cubits from the ground.

32 And the people rose for the whole day and the whole night and the whole following day and gathered the quail; the one who gathered little gathered ten cors, and they spread them to cool for themselves around the camp.

33 The meat was still in their teeth before it ran out, and the Lord was enraged against the people, and the Lord struck the people with an exceedingly great plague.

34 And the name of that place was called Graves of Desire, because there they buried the people who desired.

35 From Graves of Desire the people set out for Aseroth, and the people were in Aseroth.

Chapter 12

1 And Mariam and Aaron spoke against Moses on account of the Ethiopian woman whom Moses took, because he took an Ethiopian woman,

2 and they said: Has the Lord spoken only to Moses? Has he not also spoken to us? And the Lord heard.

3 And the man Moses was exceedingly gentle beyond all the people who were upon the earth.

4 And the Lord immediately said to Moses and Mariam and Aaron: You three, come out to the tent of testimony. And the three came out to the tent of testimony.

5 And the Lord descended in a pillar of cloud and stood at the door of the tent of testimony, and Aaron and Mariam were called, and both came out.

6 And he said to them: Hear my words. If there is a prophet of yours for the Lord, I shall be known to him in a vision, and in sleep I shall speak to him.

7 Not so my attendant Moses; in my whole house he is faithful;

8 mouth to mouth I shall speak to him, in form and not through riddles, and he saw the glory of the Lord; and why were you not afraid to speak against my attendant Moses?

9 And the wrath of the Lord's anger was upon them, and he departed.

10 And the cloud withdrew from the tent, and behold, Mariam was leprous like snow; and Aaron looked upon Mariam, and behold, she was leprous.

11 And Aaron said to Moses: Please, my lord, may he not lay sin upon us together, because we acted ignorantly in that we sinned;

12 let her not become as one equal to death, like an aborted fetus coming out of a mother's womb and devouring half of her flesh.

13 And Moses cried out to the Lord, saying: O God, I ask you, heal her.

14 And the Lord said to Moses: If her father, spitting, had spat into her face, would she not be ashamed for seven days? Let her be set apart outside the camp for seven days, and after these things she shall enter.

15 And Mariam was set apart outside the camp for seven days; and the people did not set out until Mariam was cleansed.

16 And after these things the people set out from Aseroth and encamped in the wilderness of Pharan.

Chapter 13

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Send men for yourself, and let them spy out the land of the Chananeans that I am giving to the sons of Israel as a possession; one man per tribe according to the communities of their paternal families you shall send them, every one a leader from among them.

3 And Moses sent them out from the wilderness of Pharan by the voice of the Lord; all these men were leaders of the sons of Israel.

4 And these are their names: from the tribe of Reuben, Salamiel son of Zacchour;

5 from the tribe of Symeon, Saphat son of Souri;

6 from the tribe of Judas, Chaleb son of Jephonne;

7 from the tribe of Issachar, Igaal son of Joseph;

8 from the tribe of Ephraim, Ause son of Nave;

9 from the tribe of Benjamin, Phalti son of Raphou;

10 from the tribe of Zaboulon, Goudiel son of Soudi;

11 from the tribe of Joseph, from the sons of Manasse, Gaddi son of Sousi;

12 from the tribe of Dan, Amiel son of Gamali;

13 from the tribe of Aser, Sathour son of Michael;

14 from the tribe of Nephthali, Nabi son of Jabi;

15 from the tribe of Gad, Goudiel son of Machi.

16 These are the names of the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land. And Moses named Ause son of Nave Jesus.

17 And Moses sent them to spy out the land of Chanaan and said to them: Go up by this wilderness, and you shall go up into the mountain,

18 and you shall see the land, what it is, and the people settled upon it, whether it is stronger or weak, whether they are few or many;

19 and what is the land upon which these are settled, whether it is good or evil; and what are the cities in which these dwell, whether walled or unwalled;

20 and what is the land, whether rich or neglected, whether there are trees in it or not; and persevere, and you shall take from the fruits of the land. And the days were days of spring, forerunners of the grape.

21 And they went up and spied out the land from the wilderness of Sin as far as Raab, as they enter Ephaath.

22 And they went up by the wilderness and came as far as Chebron, and there were Achiman and Sessi and Thelamin, generations of Enach; and Chebron was built seven years before Tanin of Egypt.

23 And they came as far as the Ravine of the Cluster and spied it out; and they cut from there a vine branch and one cluster of grapes upon it and carried it upon carrying poles, and some of the pomegranates and some of the figs.

24 They named that place Ravine of the Cluster because of the cluster that the sons of Israel cut from there.

25 And they returned from there after spying out the land, after forty days,

26 and they traveled and came to Moses and Aaron and to the entire congregation of the sons of Israel in the wilderness of Pharan Kades, and they answered a word to them and to the entire congregation and showed the fruit of the land.

27 And they recounted to him and said: We came into the land into which you sent us, a land flowing with milk and honey, and this is its fruit;

28 except that the nation inhabiting it is bold, and the cities are fortified, walled, and exceedingly great, and we have seen the generation of Enach there,

29 and Amalek dwells in the land toward the south, and the Chettite and the Evite and the Jebousite and the Amorrite dwell in the hill country, and the Chananite dwells by the sea and by the Jordan River.

30 And Chaleb silenced the people before Moses and said to him: No, but having gone up, we shall go up and inherit it, because, being able, we shall be able against them.

31 And the men who went up together with him said: We are not going up, because we shall certainly not be able to go up against the nation, because it is stronger than us by far.

32 And they brought out consternation concerning the land that they had spied out to the sons of Israel, saying: The land through which we passed to spy it out is a land devouring those who inhabit it; all the people whom we saw in it are exceedingly tall men;

33 and there we saw the giants, and we were before them like locusts, and thus we also were before them.

Chapter 14

1 And the entire congregation took up and gave voice, and the people wept that whole night.

2 And all the sons of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, and the entire congregation said to them: Would that we had died in the land of Egypt, or if we had died in this wilderness!

3 And why does the Lord bring us into this land to fall in war? Our wives and children shall be for plunder; now, therefore, it is better for us to turn back to Egypt.

4 And they said to one another: Let us appoint a leader and turn back to Egypt.

5 And Moses and Aaron fell upon their face before the entire congregation of the sons of Israel.

6 But Jesus, the one of Nave, and Chaleb, the one of Jephonne, from those who spied out the land, tore their garments

7 and spoke to the entire congregation of the sons of Israel, saying: The land that we spied out is exceedingly, exceedingly good;

8 if the Lord chooses us, he will bring us into this land and give it to us, a land that is flowing with milk and honey.

9 But do not become apostates from the Lord; and you, do not fear the people of the land, because they are food for us; for their time has departed from them, but the Lord is among us; do not fear them.

10 And the entire congregation said to stone them with stones. And the glory of the Lord appeared in a cloud upon the tent of testimony among all the sons of Israel.

11 And the Lord said to Moses: How long does this people provoke me, and how long do they not believe me amid all the signs that I performed among them?

12 I will strike them with death and destroy them, and I will make you and the house of your father into a great nation, and much more than this.

13 And Moses said to the Lord: And Egypt will hear that by your strength you brought this people up from among them,

14 but all those inhabiting this land have also heard that you are the Lord among this people, that you, Lord, appear eye to eye, and your cloud stands over them, and in a pillar of cloud you go before them by day and in a pillar of fire by night.

15 And you will destroy this people as one man, and the nations, as many as have heard your name, will speak, saying:

16 Because the Lord was not able to bring this people into the land that he swore to them, he laid them low in the wilderness.

17 And now let your strength be exalted, Lord, in the manner that you spoke, saying:

18 The Lord is long-suffering and abundant in mercy and true, taking away lawlessnesses and injustices and sins, and by cleansing he will not cleanse the guilty, repaying the sins of fathers upon children to the third and fourth.

19 Forgive the sin for this people according to your great mercy, just as you became gracious to them from Egypt until now.

20 And the Lord said to Moses: I am gracious to them according to your word;

21 but I live, and my name is living, and the glory of the Lord shall fill all the earth,

22 because all the men who see my glory and the signs that I performed in Egypt and in this wilderness, and tested me this tenth time and did not listen to my voice,

23 surely shall not see the land that I swore to their fathers, except their children who are here with me, as many as do not know good or evil, every inexperienced younger person; to these I will give the land, but all who provoked me shall not see it.

24 But my servant Chaleb, because another spirit came to be in him and he followed me, I will bring him into the land into which he entered there, and his seed shall inherit it.

25 But Amalek and the Chananite dwell in the valley; tomorrow turn back and set out into the wilderness by the road toward the Red Sea.

26 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

27 How long this evil congregation? I have heard the things that they themselves murmur before me, the murmuring of the sons of Israel that they murmured about you.

28 Say to them: I live, says the Lord; surely, in the manner that you spoke into my ears, so I will do to you.

29 In this wilderness your carcasses shall fall, and all your muster and those of you who were counted from twenty years old and above, as many as murmured against me;

30 you shall certainly not enter the land upon which I stretched out my hand to settle you upon it, except Chaleb son of Jephonne and Jesus, the one of Nave.

31 And the children whom you said would be for plunder, I will bring them into the land, and they shall inherit the land from which you turned away.

32 And your carcasses shall fall in this wilderness,

33 but your sons shall be grazing in the wilderness for forty years and shall bear your fornication, until your carcasses are consumed in the wilderness.

34 According to the number of the days for which you spied out the land, forty days, a day for a year, you shall receive your sins for forty years and shall know the fury of my wrath.

35 I, the Lord, have spoken; surely thus I will do to this evil congregation that has banded together against me; in this wilderness they shall be utterly consumed, and there they shall die.

36 And the men whom Moses sent to spy out the land, who returned and caused the congregation to murmur against it by bringing out evil words concerning the land,

37 the men who spoke evil against the land also died in the plague before the Lord;

38 and Jesus son of Nave and Chaleb son of Jephonne lived from among those men who had gone to spy out the land.

39 And Moses spoke these words to all the sons of Israel, and the people mourned exceedingly.

40 And rising early in the morning, they went up to the summit of the mountain, saying: Behold, here we are; we will go up to the place that the Lord spoke of, because we sinned.

41 And Moses said: Why are you transgressing the word of the Lord? It shall not be prosperous for you.

42 Do not go up, for the Lord is not with you, and you shall fall before the face of your enemies.

43 For Amalek and the Chananite are there before you, and you shall fall by the sword; because you turned away, disobeying the Lord, the Lord shall not be among you.

44 And forcing their way, they went up to the summit of the mountain; but the ark of the covenant of the Lord and Moses did not move from the camp.

45 And Amalek and the Chananite who dwelt on that mountain came down and routed them and cut them down as far as Erman; and they returned to the camp.

Chapter 15

1 And the Lord said to Moses, saying:

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: Whenever you enter into the land of your dwelling that I am giving you,

3 and you make whole burnt offerings to the Lord, a whole offering or a sacrifice, to magnify a vow or according to a voluntary offering or at your festivals, to make an odor of sweetness to the Lord, whether from the cattle or from the sheep,

4 then the one presenting his gift to the Lord shall present a sacrifice of fine flour, one-tenth of an oiphi, worked with oil in one-fourth of a hin;

5 and as wine for a libation you shall make one-fourth of a hin upon the whole burnt offering or upon the sacrifice; for the one lamb you shall make this much, an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

6 And for the ram, whenever you make it either as a whole burnt offering or as a sacrifice, you shall make a sacrifice of fine flour, two-tenths worked with oil, one-third of a hin;

7 and as wine for a libation you shall present one-third of a hin for an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

8 But if you make something from the cattle as a whole burnt offering or as a sacrifice to magnify a vow or as salvation to the Lord,

9 then he shall present upon the calf a sacrifice of fine flour, three-tenths worked with oil, half of a hin,

10 and as wine for a libation half of a hin, an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

11 Thus you shall do for the one calf or the one ram or the one lamb from the sheep or from the goats;

12 according to the number of those that you make, thus you shall do for each one according to their number.

13 Every native shall thus make such things, to present offerings for an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

14 And if a proselyte comes to be among you in your land, or whoever comes to be among you throughout your generations, and makes an offering, an odor of sweetness to the Lord, in the manner that you do, so the congregation shall do to the Lord.

15 There shall be one law for you and for the proselytes attached among you, an eternal law throughout your generations; as you are, so shall the proselyte be before the Lord;

16 there shall be one law and there shall be one ordinance for you and for the proselyte attached among you.

17 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

18 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: When you enter into the land into which I am bringing you there,

19 then it shall be, whenever you eat from the breads of the land, that you shall remove a removal offering, a separation, for the Lord;

20 as first produce of your dough, bread, you shall separate it as a removal offering; as a removal offering from a threshing floor, so you shall remove it,

21 as first produce of your dough, and you shall give a removal offering to the Lord throughout your generations.

22 But whenever you err and do not perform all these commandments that the Lord spoke to Moses,

23 in the manner that the Lord instructed you through the hand of Moses, from the day when the Lord instructed you and onward throughout your generations,

24 then it shall be, if it happens involuntarily from the eyes of the congregation, that the entire congregation shall make one unblemished calf from cattle as a whole burnt offering for an odor of sweetness to the Lord, and its sacrifice and its libation according to the ordinance, and one male kid from goats concerning sin.

25 And the priest shall make atonement concerning the entire congregation of the sons of Israel, and it shall be forgiven them, because it is involuntary, and they themselves brought their gift, an offering to the Lord concerning their sin before the Lord, concerning their involuntary acts.

26 And it shall be forgiven throughout the entire congregation of the sons of Israel and the proselyte attached to you, because it was involuntary for all the people. –

27 But if one soul sins involuntarily, he shall bring one year-old female goat concerning sin,

28 and the priest shall make atonement concerning the soul that acted involuntarily and sinned involuntarily before the Lord, to make atonement concerning him.

29 For the native among the sons of Israel and for the proselyte attached among them, there shall be one law for them, whoever acts involuntarily.

30 And a soul who acts with a hand of arrogance, whether from the natives or from the proselytes, this person provokes God; that soul shall be utterly destroyed from its people,

31 because it held the word of the Lord cheap and scattered his commandments; with an obliteration that soul shall be obliterated; its sin is in it.

32 And the sons of Israel were in the wilderness and found a man gathering wood on the day of the Sabbaths.

33 And those who found him gathering wood on the day of the Sabbaths brought him to Moses and Aaron and to the entire congregation of the sons of Israel.

34 And they placed him in custody, for they had not determined what they should do to him.

35 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Let the man be put to death by death; the entire congregation, stone him with stones.

36 And the entire congregation brought him outside the camp, and the entire congregation stoned him with stones outside the camp, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses.

37 And the Lord said to Moses, saying:

38 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: And let them make for themselves fringes upon the wings of their garments throughout their generations, and you shall place upon the fringes of the wings a hyacinth-colored thread.

39 And it shall be for you in the fringes, and you shall see them and remember all the commandments of the Lord and perform them, and you shall not turn aside after your minds and after your eyes, in which you commit fornication after them,

40 so that you may remember and perform all my commandments and shall be holy to your God.

41 I am the Lord your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt to be your God; I am the Lord your God.

Chapter 16

1 And Kore spoke, son of Issaar son of Kaath son of Levi, and Dathan and Abiron, sons of Eliab, and Aun son of Phaleth son of Reuben,

2 and they rose before Moses, along with two hundred fifty men from the sons of Israel, leaders of the congregation, summoned members of the council and men of renown.

3 They banded together against Moses and Aaron and said: Let it be enough for you, because the entire congregation, all of them, are holy, and the Lord is among them; and why do you rise up against the congregation of the Lord?

4 And Moses heard and fell upon his face,

5 and he spoke to Kore and to his entire congregation, saying: God has mustered and known those who are his and the holy ones and brought them to himself, and those whom he chose for himself he brought to himself.

6 Do this: take fire-pans for yourselves, Kore and his entire congregation,

7 and place fire upon them and place incense upon them before the Lord tomorrow, and it shall be that the man whom the Lord chooses, this one is holy; let it be sufficient for you, sons of Levi.

8 And Moses said to Kore: Listen to me, sons of Levi.

9 Is this a small thing for you, that the God of Israel distinguished you from the congregation of Israel and brought you to himself to minister the ministries of the tent of the Lord and to stand before the congregation to serve them?

10 And he brought you and all your brothers, the sons of Levi, with you, and do you seek to serve as priests?

11 Thus you and your entire congregation are gathered together against God; and who is Aaron, that you murmur against him?

12 And Moses sent to call Dathan and Abiron, sons of Eliab. And they said: We are not going up.

13 Is this not a small thing, that you brought us up from a land flowing with milk and honey to kill us in the wilderness, that you rule over us as a ruler?

14 Even if you had brought us into a land flowing with milk and honey and given us an allotment of field and vineyards, would you have cut out the eyes of those men? We are not going up.

15 And Moses became exceedingly heavy-spirited and said to the Lord: Do not attend to their sacrifice; I have taken no desirable thing from any of them, nor have I harmed any of them.

16 And Moses said to Kore: Sanctify your congregation, and be ready before the Lord, you and they and Aaron, tomorrow;

17 and each of you take his fire-pan and you shall place incense upon them and shall bring before the Lord, each one, his fire-pan, two hundred fifty fire-pans, and you and Aaron, each his fire-pan.

18 And each took his fire-pan, and they placed fire upon them and put incense upon it. And Moses and Aaron stood by the doors of the tent of testimony.

19 And Kore gathered his entire congregation together against them by the door of the tent of testimony. And the glory of the Lord appeared to the entire congregation.

20 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

21 Separate yourselves from the midst of this congregation, and I will utterly consume them at once.

22 And they fell upon their face and said: God, God of the spirits and of all flesh, if one person sinned, shall the wrath of the Lord be upon the entire congregation?

23 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

24 Speak to the congregation, saying: Withdraw all around from the congregation of Kore.

25 And Moses rose and went to Dathan and Abiron, and all the elders of Israel went together with him.

26 And he spoke to the congregation, saying: Separate yourselves from the tents of these hard men, and do not touch any of the things that are theirs, lest you perish together in all their sin.

27 And they withdrew from the tent of Kore all around; and Dathan and Abiron came out and stood by the doors of their tents, along with their wives and their children and their equipment.

28 And Moses said: By this you shall know that the Lord sent me to perform all these works, because they are not from myself:

29 if these die according to the death of all people, and if according to the muster of all people there shall be a muster of them, the Lord has not sent me;

30 but rather, the Lord shall show it by a spectacle, and the earth, opening its mouth, shall swallow them and their houses and their tents and all that is theirs, and they shall descend alive into Hades, and you shall know that these men provoked the Lord.

31 And when he ceased speaking all these words, the earth split beneath them,

32 and the earth opened and swallowed them and their houses and all the people who were with Kore and their livestock.

33 And they and all that was theirs descended alive into Hades, and the earth covered them, and they perished from the midst of the congregation.

34 And all Israel who were around them fled from their voice, saying: Lest the earth swallow us.

35 And fire went out from the Lord and devoured the two hundred fifty men who were presenting the incense.

Chapter 17

1 And the Lord said to Moses,

2 and to Eleazar son of Aaron the priest: Take up the bronze fire-pans from the midst of those who were burned up, and scatter this strange fire there, because they sanctified

3 the fire-pans of these sinners in their souls; and make them into hammered plates, a covering for the altar, because they were presented before the Lord and were sanctified and became a sign for the sons of Israel.

4 And Eleazar son of Aaron the priest took the bronze fire-pans, as many as those who had been burned up presented, and they added them as a covering for the altar,

5 a memorial for the sons of Israel, so that no foreigner who is not from the seed of Aaron may approach to place incense before the Lord, and he shall not be like Kore and his conspiracy, in the manner that the Lord spoke through the hand of Moses.

6 And on the next day the sons of Israel murmured against Moses and Aaron, saying: You have killed the people of the Lord.

7 And it happened, when the congregation gathered together against Moses and Aaron and rushed toward the tent of testimony, that the cloud covered it, and the glory of the Lord appeared.

8 And Moses and Aaron entered before the face of the tent of testimony,

9 and the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

10 Move out from the midst of this congregation, and I will utterly consume them at once. And they fell upon their face.

11 And Moses said to Aaron: Take the fire-pan and place fire from the altar upon it and put incense upon it and carry it away with speed into the camp and make atonement concerning them; for wrath has gone out from the face of the Lord; it has begun to break the people.

12 And Aaron took it, just as Moses spoke to him, and ran into the congregation; and the breaking had already begun among the people; and he put on the incense and made atonement concerning the people,

13 and he stood between the dead and the living, and the breaking abated.

14 And those who died in the breaking were fourteen thousand seven hundred, apart from those who died on account of Kore.

15 And Aaron returned to Moses at the door of the tent of testimony, and the breaking abated.

16 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

17 Speak to the sons of Israel, and take from them a staff, a staff according to their paternal houses, from all their rulers according to their paternal houses, twelve staffs, and inscribe the name of each one upon his staff.

18 And inscribe the name of Aaron upon the staff of Levi; for there is one staff; according to a tribe of their paternal house they shall give.

19 And you shall place them in the tent of testimony opposite the testimony, where I shall be known to you there.

20 And it shall be that the man whom I choose, his staff shall sprout; and I shall take away from me the murmuring of the sons of Israel that they themselves murmur against you.

21 And Moses spoke to the sons of Israel, and all their rulers gave him a staff, for the one ruler a staff, a staff according to each ruler according to their paternal houses, twelve staffs, and the staff of Aaron was among their staffs.

22 And Moses placed the staffs before the Lord in the tent of testimony.

23 And it happened on the next day that Moses and Aaron entered the tent of testimony, and behold, the staff of Aaron for the house of Levi had sprouted, and it brought out a shoot and blossomed flowers and sprouted nuts.

24 And Moses brought out all the staffs from before the Lord to all the sons of Israel, and they saw, and each took his staff.

25 And the Lord said to Moses: Place the staff of Aaron before the testimonies for preservation, as a sign to the sons of the disobedient, and let their murmuring cease from me, and they shall certainly not die.

26 And Moses and Aaron did in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses; so they did.

27 And the sons of Israel spoke to Moses, saying: Behold, we have been utterly consumed, we have perished, we have been consumed away;

28 everyone who touches the tent of the Lord dies; shall we die to the end?

Chapter 18

1 And the Lord said to Aaron, saying: You and your sons and the house of your paternal family shall receive the sins of the holy things, and you and your sons shall receive the sins of your priesthood.

2 And bring your brothers, the tribe of Levi, the community of your father, to yourself, and let them be added to you and minister to you; and you and your sons with you shall be before the tent of testimony.

3 And they shall keep your watches and the watches of the tent, except they shall not approach the holy vessels or the altar, and both these and you shall not die.

4 And they shall be added to you and shall keep the watches of the tent of testimony according to all the ministries of the tent, and the foreigner shall not approach you.

5 And you shall keep the watches of the holy things and the watches of the altar, and there shall be no wrath among the sons of Israel.

6 And I have taken your brothers the Levites from the midst of the sons of Israel, a gift given to the Lord to minister the ministries of the tent of testimony;

7 and you and your sons with you shall preserve your priesthood according to every manner of the altar and what is within the veil, and you shall minister the ministries as a gift of your priesthood; and the foreigner who approaches shall die.

8 And the Lord spoke to Aaron: And I, behold, have given you the custody of the first produce; from all the things sanctified to me by the sons of Israel I have given them to you as an honorary portion, and to your sons after you, as an eternal ordinance.

9 And this shall be for you from the sanctified holy things of the offerings: from all their gifts and from all their sacrifices and from every trespass of theirs and from all the sins, as many things as they render to me; from all the holy things it shall belong to you and your sons.

10 In the Holy of Holies you shall eat them; every male shall eat them, you and your sons; they shall be holy things for you.

11 And this shall be for you as first produce of their gifts: from all the placements of the sons of Israel I have given them to you and your sons and your daughters with you, as an eternal ordinance; every clean person in your house shall eat them.

12 Every first produce of oil and every first produce of wine and grain, their first produce, as much as they give to the Lord, I have given them to you.

13 All the first products, as many as are in their land, as much as they bring to the Lord, shall be yours; every clean person in your house shall eat them.

14 Everything anathematized among the sons of Israel shall be yours.

15 And everything opening the womb from all flesh that they present to the Lord, from human to livestock, shall be yours; except the firstborn of humans shall be redeemed with ransoms, and you shall redeem the firstborn of unclean livestock.

16 And its redemption shall be from one month old; the valuation is five shekels according to the holy shekel [they are twenty obols].

17 Except you shall not redeem firstborn calves or firstborn sheep or firstborn goats; they are holy; and you shall pour their blood toward the altar and bring up the fat as an offering for an odor of sweetness to the Lord;

18 and the flesh shall be yours; just as the breast of the placement and according to the right arm, it shall be yours.

19 Every removal offering from the holy things, as much as the sons of Israel remove for the Lord, I have given to you and your sons and your daughters with you, as an eternal ordinance; it is an eternal covenant of salt before the Lord for you and your seed after you.

20 And the Lord spoke to Aaron: In their land you shall not inherit, and there shall be no portion for you among them, because I am your portion and your inheritance in the midst of the sons of Israel.

21 And to the sons of Levi, behold, I have given every tithe in Israel as an allotment in exchange for their ministries, as many things as they themselves minister as a ministry in the tent of testimony.

22 And the sons of Israel shall no longer approach the tent of testimony to receive death-bearing sin.

23 And the Levite himself shall minister the ministry of the tent of testimony, and they shall receive their sins, an eternal ordinance throughout their generations; and in the midst of the sons of Israel they shall not inherit an inheritance;

24 because the tithes of the sons of Israel, as many as they set apart for the Lord as a removal offering, I have given to the Levites as an allotment; therefore I have said to them: In the midst of the sons of Israel they shall not inherit an allotment.

25 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

26 And you shall speak to the Levites and say to them: If you receive from the sons of Israel the tithe that I gave you from them as an allotment, then you shall remove from it a removal offering to the Lord, a tithe from the tithe.

27 And your removal offerings shall be reckoned to you as grain from a threshing floor and a removal offering from a winepress.

28 Thus you also shall remove from the removal offerings of the Lord, from all your tithes, as many as you receive from the sons of Israel, and you shall give from them a removal offering to the Lord, to Aaron the priest.

29 From all your gifts you shall remove a removal offering to the Lord, or from all the first produce, the thing sanctified from it.

30 And you shall say to them: Whenever you remove the first produce from it, then it shall be reckoned to the Levites as produce from a threshing floor and as produce from a winepress.

31 And you and your households shall eat it in every place, because this is wages for you in exchange for your ministries in the tent of testimony;

32 and you shall not receive sin through it, because you remove the first produce from it; and you shall not profane the holy things of the sons of Israel, so that you may not die.

Chapter 19

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses and Aaron, saying:

2 This is the distinction of the law, as many things as the Lord instructed, saying: Speak to the sons of Israel, and let them take for you an unblemished red heifer that has no blemish in it and upon which no yoke has been laid.

3 And you shall give her to Eleazar the priest, and they shall lead her outside the camp to a clean place and shall slaughter her before him.

4 And Eleazar shall take from her blood and shall sprinkle some of her blood seven times opposite the face of the tent of testimony.

5 And they shall burn her up before him, and her skin and her flesh and her blood together with her dung shall be burned up.

6 And the priest shall take cedar wood and hyssop and scarlet, and they shall throw them into the midst of the burning of the heifer.

7 And the priest shall wash his garments and bathe his body with water and after these things shall enter the camp, and the priest shall be unclean until evening.

8 And the one burning her shall wash his garments and bathe his body and shall be unclean until evening.

9 And a clean person shall gather the ash of the heifer and deposit it outside the camp in a clean place, and it shall be for the congregation of the sons of Israel for custody, water of sprinkling; it is purification.

10 And the one gathering the ash of the heifer shall wash his garments and shall be unclean until evening. And it shall be an eternal ordinance for the sons of Israel and the proselytes attached to them.

11 The one who touches the dead body of any human person shall be unclean for seven days;

12 this one shall be purified on the third day and on the seventh day and shall be clean; but if he is not thoroughly purified on the third day and on the seventh day, he shall not be clean.

13 Everyone who touches the dead body of a human person when he dies and is not thoroughly purified has defiled the tent of the Lord; that soul shall be obliterated from Israel; because water of sprinkling was not sprinkled around upon him, he is unclean; his uncleanness is still in him.

14 And this is the law: if a person dies in a house, everyone entering the house and as many things as are in the house shall be unclean for seven days;

15 and every opened vessel, as many as have no fastening bound down upon them, are unclean.

16 And everyone who touches upon the face of the open country a wounded person or a dead person or a human bone or a tomb shall be unclean for seven days.

17 And they shall take for the unclean person some of the ash of the burned purification and shall pour living water upon it into a vessel;

18 and a clean man shall take hyssop and dip it into the water and sprinkle it around upon the house and upon the vessels and upon the souls, as many as are there, and upon the one who touched the human bone or the wounded person or the one who died or the tomb;

19 and the clean person shall sprinkle it around upon the unclean person on the third day and on the seventh day, and he shall be thoroughly purified on the seventh day and shall wash his garments and bathe with water and shall be unclean until evening.

20 And a person who is defiled and is not thoroughly purified—that soul shall be utterly destroyed from the midst of the congregation, because he defiled the holy things of the Lord, because water of sprinkling was not sprinkled around upon him; he is unclean.

21 And it shall be an eternal ordinance for you; and the one sprinkling around the water of sprinkling shall wash his garments, and the one touching the water of sprinkling shall be unclean until evening;

22 and everything that the unclean person touches shall be unclean, and the soul that touches it shall be unclean until evening.

Chapter 20

1 And the sons of Israel, the entire congregation, came into the wilderness of Sin in the first month, and the people remained in Kades, and Mariam died there and was buried there.

2 And there was no water for the congregation, and they gathered together against Moses and Aaron.

3 And the people reviled Moses, saying: Would that we had died in the destruction of our brothers before the Lord;

4 and why did you bring the congregation of the Lord up into this wilderness, to kill us and our livestock?

5 And why did you bring us up from Egypt for this, to arrive at this evil place? A place where there is no sowing, nor fig trees, nor vines, nor pomegranates, nor water to drink.

6 And Moses and Aaron went from before the face of the congregation to the door of the tent of testimony and fell upon their face, and the glory of the Lord appeared to them.

7 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

8 Take the staff and assemble the congregation, you and Aaron your brother, and speak to the rock before them, and it shall give its waters, and you shall bring out water for them from the rock and give drink to the congregation and their livestock.

9 And Moses took the staff that was before the Lord, in the manner that the Lord instructed;

10 and Moses and Aaron assembled the congregation before the rock and said to them: Listen to me, disobedient ones; shall we bring water out for you from this rock?

11 And Moses lifted up his hand and struck the rock twice with the staff, and much water came out, and the congregation and their livestock drank.

12 And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron: Because you did not believe so as to sanctify me before the sons of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this congregation into the land that I have given them.

13 This is water of contradiction, because the sons of Israel reviled before the Lord, and he was sanctified among them.

14 And Moses sent messengers from Kades to the king of Edom, saying: Thus says your brother Israel: You know all the hardship that found us,

15 and our fathers went down into Egypt, and we sojourned in Egypt for more days, and the Egyptians harmed us and our fathers,

16 and we cried out to the Lord, and the Lord listened to our voice and, sending an angel, brought us out of Egypt; and now we are in Kades, a city at the edge of your borders;

17 we shall pass through your land; we shall not pass through fields or through vineyards, nor shall we drink water from your cistern; we shall travel by the royal road; we shall not turn right or left until we have passed your borders.

18 And Edom said to him: You shall not pass through me; otherwise I will go out in war to meet you.

19 And the sons of Israel said to him: We shall pass along the mountain; and if I and the livestock drink from your water, I will give you a price; but the matter is nothing; we shall pass along the mountain.

20 But he said: You shall not pass through me; and Edom went out to meet him with a heavy crowd and with a strong hand.

21 And Edom did not wish to allow Israel to pass through his borders; and Israel turned away from him.

22 And they departed from Kades; and the sons of Israel, the entire congregation, arrived at Or the mountain.

23 And the Lord said to Moses and Aaron at Or the mountain, upon the borders of the land of Edom, saying:

24 Let Aaron be added to his people, because you shall certainly not enter into the land that I gave to the sons of Israel, because you provoked me at the water of reviling.

25 Take Aaron and Eleazar his son and bring them up to Or the mountain before the entire congregation,

26 and strip Aaron of his robe and clothe Eleazar his son, and let Aaron, being added, die there.

27 And Moses did in the manner that the Lord instructed, and he brought him up to Or the mountain before the entire congregation.

28 And he stripped Aaron of his garments and clothed Eleazar his son with them; and Aaron died upon the summit of the mountain, and Moses and Eleazar came down from the mountain.

29 And the entire congregation saw that Aaron had been released, and the entire house of Israel wept for Aaron for thirty days.

Chapter 21

1 And Chananis, king of Arad, who dwelt along the wilderness, heard – for Israel came by the road Atharin – and he waged war against Israel, and they took captives from them as plunder.

2 And Israel vowed a vow to the Lord and said: If you deliver this people under my hand, I will anathematize him and his cities.

3 And the Lord listened to the voice of Israel and delivered Chananis under his hand, and he anathematized him and his cities; and they called the name of that place Anathema.

4 And setting out from Or the mountain by the road toward the Red Sea, they went around the land of Edom; and the people became fainthearted on the road.

5 And the people spoke against God and against Moses, saying: Why did you bring us out of Egypt to kill us in the wilderness? Because there is no bread or water, and our soul is disgusted with the empty bread.

6 And the Lord sent among the people the serpents that cause death, and they bit the people, and many people from the sons of Israel died.

7 And the people came to Moses and said: We sinned because we spoke against the Lord and against you; therefore pray to the Lord, and let him take the serpent away from us. And Moses prayed to the Lord concerning the people.

8 And the Lord said to Moses: Make a serpent for yourself and place it upon a sign, and it shall be that if a serpent bites a person, every person who has been bitten, seeing it, shall live.

9 And Moses made a bronze serpent and stood it upon a sign, and it happened whenever a serpent bit a person and he looked upon the bronze serpent that he lived.

10 And the sons of Israel departed and encamped in Oboth.

11 And setting out from Oboth, they encamped in Achelgai from beyond, in the wilderness that is opposite Moab toward the rising of the sun.

12 From there they departed and encamped in the ravine Zaret.

13 And setting out from there, they encamped beyond Arnon in the wilderness that extends from the borders of the Amorrites; for Arnon is the boundary of Moab, between Moab and between the Amorrite.

14 Therefore it is said in a book, War of the Lord: He set Zoob aflame and the torrents of Arnon,

15 and he established the torrents to settle Er, and it lies adjacent to the borders of Moab.

16 And from there to the well; this is the well of which the Lord said to Moses: Gather the people, and I will give them water to drink.

17 Then Israel sang this song at the well: Begin for it;

18 a well—the rulers dug it; kings of nations quarried it in their kingdom, when they ruled them. And from the well to Manthanain;

19 and from Manthanain to Naaliel; and from Naaliel to Bamoth;

20 and from Bamoth to the valley that is in the plain of Moab, from the summit of the hewn rock that looks toward the face of the wilderness.

21 And Moses sent ambassadors to Seon king of the Amorrites with peaceful words, saying:

22 We shall pass through your land; we shall travel by the road; we shall not turn aside into a field or into a vineyard; we shall not drink water from your well; we shall travel by the royal road until we have passed your borders.

23 And Seon did not allow Israel to pass through his borders, and Seon gathered all his people and went out to array himself against Israel in the wilderness and came to Jassa and arrayed himself against Israel.

24 And Israel struck him with slaughter of the sword and took mastery of his land from Arnon as far as Jabok, as far as the sons of Amman; because Jazer is the boundary of the sons of Ammon.

25 And Israel took all these cities, and Israel dwelt in all the cities of the Amorrites, in Esebon and in all those contiguous to it.

26 For Esebon is a city of Seon king of the Amorrites, and this one formerly waged war against the king of Moab, and they took all his land from Aroer as far as Arnon.

27 Therefore the speakers of riddles will say: Come to Esebon, so that the city of Seon may be built and prepared.

28 Because fire went out from Esebon, a flame from the city of Seon, and devoured as far as Moab and swallowed the pillars of Arnon.

29 Woe to you, Moab; you perished, people of Chamos. Their sons were given over to be preserved, and their daughters as captives to Seon king of the Amorrites;

30 and their seed shall perish, Esebon as far as Daibon, and the women still kindled fire further against Moab.

31 And Israel dwelt in all the cities of the Amorrites.

32 And Moses sent to spy out Jazer, and they took it and its villages and drove out the Amorrite who dwelt there. –

33 And turning, they went up the road to Basan; and Og king of Basan went out to meet them, and all his people, for war at Edrain.

34 And the Lord said to Moses: Do not fear him, because I have delivered him and all his people and all his land into your hands, and you shall do to him just as you did to Seon king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Esebon.

35 And he struck him and his sons and all his people until no living captive of his was left; and they inherited their land.

Chapter 22

1 And the sons of Israel departed and encamped west of Moab by the Jordan opposite Jericho.

2 And Balak son of Sepphor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorrite,

3 and Moab feared the people exceedingly because they were many, and Moab was disgusted because of the face of the sons of Israel.

4 And Moab said to the council of elders of Madian: Now this congregation will lick up all those around us, as the calf licks up the green things from the field. And Balak son of Sepphor was king of Moab at that time.

5 And he sent ambassadors to Balaam son of Beor at Phathoura, which is upon the river of the land of the sons of his people, to call him, saying: Behold, a people has come out of Egypt, and behold, it has covered the face of the land, and this one is settled next to me;

6 and now come, curse this people for me, because this one is stronger than we are, if we may be able to strike some of them, and I will drive them out of the land; because I know that those whom you bless have been blessed, and those whom you curse have been cursed.

7 And the council of elders of Moab and the council of elders of Madian went, with the divinations in their hands, and came to Balaam and told him the words of Balak.

8 And he said to them: Lodge here for the night, and I will answer you with the matters that the Lord may speak to me. And the rulers of Moab remained beside Balaam.

9 And God came to Balaam and said to him: Who are these people beside you?

10 And Balaam said to God: Balak son of Sepphor, king of Moab, sent them to me, saying:

11 Behold, a people has come out of Egypt, and behold, it has covered the face of the land, and this one is settled next to me; and now come, curse him for me, if perhaps I may be able to strike him and drive him out of the land.

12 And God said to Balaam: You shall not go with them, nor shall you curse the people, for it is blessed.

13 And Balaam rose in the morning and said to the rulers of Balak: Run back to your lord; God does not permit me to go with you.

14 And the rulers of Moab rose and came to Balak and said: Balaam does not wish to go with us.

15 And Balak added still more rulers to send, more numerous and more honorable than these.

16 And they came to Balaam and said to him: Thus says Balak, the one of Sepphor: I entreat you, do not hesitate to come to me;

17 for with honor I will honor you, and whatever you say, I will do for you; and come, curse this people down for me.

18 And Balaam answered and said to the rulers of Balak: If Balak gives me his house full of silver and gold, I shall not be able to transgress the word of the Lord God to do it small or great in my mind;

19 and now you also remain here this night, and I shall know what the Lord will add to speak to me.

20 And God came to Balaam by night and said to him: If these men are present to call you, rise and follow them; but the word that I speak to you, this you shall do.

21 And Balaam rose in the morning, saddled his donkey, and went with the rulers of Moab. –

22 And God was enraged with anger because he went, and the angel of God rose to oppose him; and he was mounted upon his donkey, and his two servants were with him.

23 And the donkey saw the angel of God standing against him on the road, with the broadsword drawn in his hand, and the donkey turned aside from the road and went into the plain; and he struck the donkey with the staff to direct her on the road.

24 And the angel of God stood in the furrows of the vineyards, a fence on this side and a fence on that side;

25 and the donkey saw the angel of God and pressed herself against the wall and crushed Balaam's foot; and he added still more to whip her.

26 And the angel of God moved on and went and stood in a narrow place in which there was no turning to the right or the left.

27 And the donkey saw the angel of God and sat down beneath Balaam; and Balaam was angered and struck the donkey with the staff.

28 And God opened the mouth of the donkey, and she says to Balaam: What have I done to you, that you have struck me this third time?

29 And Balaam said to the donkey: Because you have mocked me; and if I had a sword in my hand, I would already have pierced you.

30 And the donkey says to Balaam: Am I not your donkey, upon whom you have ridden from your youth until this day? Have I, with contempt, despised you and done thus to you? And he said: No.

31 And God uncovered the eyes of Balaam, and he sees the angel of the Lord standing against him on the road, with the sword drawn in his hand, and bending down he worshiped upon his face.

32 And the angel of God said to him: Why did you strike your donkey this third time? And behold, I came out in opposition to you, because your road is not graceful before me.

33 And the donkey saw me and turned aside from me this third time; and if she had not turned aside, now therefore I would have killed you but preserved her.

34 And Balaam said to the angel of the Lord: I have sinned, for I did not know that you stood against me on the road for a meeting; and now, if it is not pleasing to you, I will turn back.

35 And the angel of God said to Balaam: Go together with the men; except the word that I say to you, this you shall guard to speak. And Balaam went with the rulers of Balak.

36 And Balak heard that Balaam had come and went out to meet him at a city of Moab that is upon the borders of Arnon, which is at the edge of the borders.

37 And Balak said to Balaam: Did I not send to you to call you? Why did you not come to me? Really, shall I not be able to honor you?

38 And Balaam said to Balak: Behold, I have come to you; now shall I be able to speak anything? The word that God puts into my mouth, this I shall speak.

39 And Balaam went with Balak, and they came to cities of farmsteads.

40 And Balak sacrificed sheep and calves and sent some to Balaam and to the rulers who were with him.

41 And it happened in the morning that Balak took Balaam and brought him up upon the pillar of Baal and showed him from there a certain part of the people.

Chapter 23

1 And Balaam said to Balak: Build seven altars for me here and prepare seven calves and seven rams for me here.

2 And Balak did in the manner that Balaam told him, and he brought up a calf and a ram upon the altar.

3 And Balaam said to Balak: Stand beside your sacrifice, and I will go, in case God appears to me in a meeting, and whatever word he shows me, I will report to you. And Balak stood beside his sacrifice, and Balaam went to inquire of God and went straight.

4 And God appeared to Balaam, and Balaam said to him: I prepared the seven altars and brought up a calf and a ram upon the altar.

5 And God put a word into the mouth of Balaam and said: Turn back to Balak; thus you shall speak.

6 And he turned back to him, and this one was standing over his whole burnt offerings, and all the rulers of Moab with him.

7 And the spirit of God came upon him, and taking up his parable, he said: From Mesopotamia Balak summoned me, king of Moab from the mountains from the east, saying: Come, call down a curse upon Jacob for me, and come, curse Israel down for me.

8 How shall I call down a curse upon one whom the Lord does not curse, or how shall I curse one whom God does not curse?

9 Because from the summit of mountains I shall see him, and from hills I shall consider him. Behold, a people shall dwell alone and shall not be reckoned among nations.

10 Who accurately counted the seed of Jacob, and who shall number the communities of Israel? May my soul die among the souls of the righteous, and may my seed become like the seed of these.

11 And Balak said to Balaam: What have you done to me? I called you for a curse upon my enemies, and behold, you have blessed a blessing.

12 And Balaam said to Balak: Shall I not guard to speak whatever God puts into my mouth?

13 And Balak said to him: Come still with me to another place, from which you shall not see him from there, except you shall see a certain part of him, but you shall certainly not see them all; and curse him for me from there.

14 And he took him to a lookout point of a field upon the summit of the hewn rock, and he built seven altars there and brought up a calf and a ram upon the altar.

15 And Balaam said to Balak: Stand beside your sacrifice, but I will go to inquire of God.

16 And God met Balaam and put a word into his mouth and said: Turn back to Balak, and thus you shall speak.

17 And he turned back to him, and this one was standing over his whole burnt offering, and all the rulers of Moab with him. And Balak said to him: What did the Lord speak?

18 And taking up his parable, he said: Rise, Balak, and hear; give ear, witness, son of Sepphor.

19 God is not like a human, to be deceived, nor like a son of man, to be threatened. Having said, will he not do? Will he speak and not remain by it?

20 Behold, I have received to bless; I will bless and shall certainly not turn back.

21 There shall be no hardship in Jacob, nor shall pain be seen in Israel; the Lord his God is with him, the glorious things of rulers are in him.

22 God is the one who brought them out of Egypt; like the glory of a unicorn for him.

23 For there is no augury in Jacob nor divination in Israel; at the appointed time it shall be said to Jacob and to Israel what God shall accomplish.

24 Behold, a people shall rise like a lion cub and shall exult like a lion; it shall not sleep until it eats prey, and it shall drink the blood of the wounded.

25 And Balak said to Balaam: Neither with curses shall you curse him for me, nor, blessing, shall you bless him.

26 And Balaam answered and said to Balak: Did I not speak to you, saying: The word that God speaks, this I shall do?

27 And Balak said to Balaam: Come, let me take you to another place, in case it pleases God also that you curse him for me from there.

28 And Balak took Balaam to the summit of Phogor that extends into the wilderness.

29 And Balaam said to Balak: Build seven altars for me here and prepare seven calves and seven rams for me here.

30 And Balak did just as Balaam told him, and brought up a calf and a ram upon the altar.

Chapter 24

1 And Balaam saw that it was good before the Lord to bless Israel, and he did not go according to his custom to meet with the omens, and he turned his face toward the wilderness.

2 And Balaam lifted up his eyes and beheld Israel encamped according to tribes. And the spirit of God came to be in him,

3 and taking up his parable, he said: Balaam son of Beor says, the man who truly sees says,

4 the one hearing oracles of God says, who saw a vision of God in sleep, his eyes unveiled:

5 How beautiful are your houses, Jacob, your tents, Israel;

6 like valleys giving shade and like gardens along rivers and like tents that the Lord pitched, like cedars beside waters.

7 A man shall come out from his seed and shall rule many nations, and his kingdom shall be exalted beyond Gog, and his kingdom shall increase.

8 God guided him out of Egypt; like the glory of a unicorn for him. He shall eat nations of his enemies and shall draw out the marrow of their stout parts, and with his missiles he shall shoot down an enemy.

9 Reclining, he rested like a lion and like a lion cub; who shall raise him? Those who bless you have been blessed, and those who curse you have been cursed.

10 And Balak was angered against Balaam and clapped his hands together, and Balak said to Balaam: I called you to curse my enemy, and behold, blessing, you have blessed this third time;

11 now therefore flee to your place. I said, I will honor you, and now the Lord has deprived you of glory.

12 And Balaam said to Balak: Did I not also speak to your messengers whom you sent to me, saying:

13 If Balak gives me his house full of silver and gold, I shall not be able to transgress the word of the Lord to do it evil or good from myself; whatever God says, these things I shall say?

14 And now, behold, I am running back to my place; come, I will counsel you what this people shall do to your people at the end of the days.

15 And taking up his parable, he said: Balaam son of Beor says, the man who truly sees says,

16 the one hearing oracles of God, knowing knowledge from the Most High and seeing a vision of God in sleep, his eyes unveiled:

17 I shall show him, but not now; I call him blessed, but he does not draw near; a star shall rise from Jacob, and a man shall rise from Israel and shall break the rulers of Moab and shall plunder all the sons of Seth.

18 And Edom shall be an inheritance, and Esau his enemy shall be an inheritance; and Israel acted with strength.

19 And one shall be raised from Jacob and shall destroy one being saved from a city.

20 And seeing Amalek and taking up his parable, he said: Amalek is the beginning of nations, and their seed shall perish.

21 And seeing the Kenite and taking up his parable, he said: Your dwelling is strong; and if you place your nest in a rock,

22 and if a brood of cunning comes to be for Beor, Assyrians shall take you captive.

23 And seeing Og and taking up his parable, he said: Oh, oh, who shall live whenever God establishes these things?

24 And one shall come out from the hand of the Kitians, and they shall harm Assour and shall harm the Hebrews, and they themselves shall perish with one accord.

25 And Balaam rose and went away, returning to his place, and Balak went away to himself.

Chapter 25

1 And Israel lodged in Sattin; and the people were profaned so as to commit fornication with the daughters of Moab.

2 And they called them to the sacrifices of their idols, and the people ate from their sacrifices and worshiped their idols.

3 And Israel was perfected to Beelphegor; and the Lord was enraged with wrath toward Israel.

4 And the Lord said to Moses: Take all the leaders of the people and make an example of them for the Lord before the sun, and the wrath of the Lord's anger shall turn away from Israel.

5 And Moses said to the tribes of Israel: Each of you kill his own kinsman who has been perfected to Beelphegor.

6 And behold, a man from the sons of Israel came and brought his brother to the Madianite woman before Moses and before the entire congregation of the sons of Israel, while they were weeping by the door of the tent of testimony.

7 And Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the priest saw and rose up from the midst of the congregation and took a spear in his hand,

8 and he entered behind the Israelite man into the furnace and pierced both of them, the Israelite man and the woman through her womb; and the plague ceased from the sons of Israel.

9 And those who died in the plague were twenty-four thousand.

10 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

11 Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the priest stopped my wrath from the sons of Israel by being zealous with my zeal among them, and I did not utterly consume the sons of Israel in my jealousy.

12 Thus say: Behold, I am giving him a covenant of peace,

13 and it shall be for him and his seed after him an eternal covenant of priesthood, because he was zealous for his God and made atonement concerning the sons of Israel.

14 And the name of the stricken Israelite man, who was struck with the Madianite woman, was Zambri son of Salo, ruler of a paternal house of the Symeonites;

15 and the name of the stricken Madianite woman was Chasbi daughter of Sour, ruler of the nation Ommoth; he is of a paternal house of the Madianites.

16 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Speak to the sons of Israel, saying:

17 Be hostile to the Madianites and strike them,

18 because they themselves act with hostility toward you in deceit, as many things as they deceive you through Phogor and through Chasbi daughter of a ruler of Madian, their sister, who was struck on the day of the plague through Phogor.

Chapter 26

1 And it happened after the plague that the Lord spoke to Moses and to Eleazar the priest, saying:

2 Take the head-count of the entire congregation of the sons of Israel, from twenty years old and above, according to the houses of their paternal families, everyone who goes out to be arrayed for battle in Israel.

3 And Moses and Eleazar the priest spoke in Araboth Moab by the Jordan opposite Jericho, saying:

4 From twenty years old and above, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses. And the sons of Israel who came out of Egypt:

5 Reuben, the firstborn of Israel. And the sons of Reuben: Enoch, and the community of Enoch; for Phallou, the community of Phalloui;

6 for Asron, the community of Asroni; for Charmi, the community of Charmi.

7 These are the communities of Reuben; and their muster was forty-three thousand seven hundred thirty. –

8 And the sons of Phallou: Eliab.

9 And the sons of Eliab: Namouel and Dathan and Abiron. These were those called from the congregation; these are the ones who rose together against Moses and Aaron in the congregation of Kore, in the rising together against the Lord,

10 and the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them and Kore in the death of his congregation, when the fire consumed the two hundred fifty, and they became a sign;

11 but the sons of Kore did not die.

12 And the sons of Symeon, the community of the sons of Symeon: for Namouel, the community of Namoueli; for Jamin, the community of Jamini; for Jachin, the community of Jachini;

13 for Zara, the community of Zarai; for Saul, the community of Sauli.

14 These are the communities of Symeon from their muster, twenty-two thousand two hundred.

15 And the sons of Judas: Er and Aunan; and Er and Aunan died in the land of Chanaan.

16 And the sons of Judas according to their communities were: for Selon, the community of Seloni; for Phares, the community of Phares; for Zara, the community of Zarai.

17 And the sons of Phares were: for Asron, the community of Asroni; for Jamoun, the community of Jamouni.

18 These are the communities for Judas according to their muster, seventy-six thousand five hundred.

19 And the sons of Issachar according to their communities: for Thola, the community of Tholai; for Phoua, the community of Phouai;

20 for Jasoub, the community of Jasoubi; for Samaran, the community of Samarani.

21 These are the communities of Issachar from their muster, sixty-four thousand three hundred.

22 The sons of Zaboulon according to their communities: for Sared, the community of Saredi; for Allon, the community of Alloni; for Allel, the community of Alleli.

23 These are the communities of Zaboulon from their muster, sixty thousand five hundred.

24 The sons of Gad according to their communities: for Saphon, the community of Saphoni; for Angi, the community of Angi; for Souni, the community of Souni;

25 for Azeni, the community of Azeni; for Addi, the community of Addi;

26 for Aroadi, the community of Aroadi; for Ariel, the community of Arieli.

27 These are the communities of the sons of Gad from their muster, forty thousand five hundred.

28 The sons of Aser according to their communities: for Jamin, the community of Jamini; for Jesou, the community of Jesoui; for Baria, the community of Bariai;

29 for Chober, the community of Choberi; for Melchiel, the community of Melchieli.

30 And the name of the daughter of Aser was Sara.

31 These are the communities of Aser from their muster, fifty-three thousand four hundred.

32 The sons of Joseph according to their communities: Manasse and Ephraim. –

33 The sons of Manasse: for Machir, the community of Machiri; and Machir begot Galaad; for Galaad, the community of Galaadi.

34 And these are the sons of Galaad: for Achiezer, the community of Achiezeri; for Cheleg, the community of Chelegi;

35 for Esriel, the community of Esrieli; for Sychem, the community of Sychemi;

36 for Symaer, the community of Symaeri; and for Opher, the community of Opheri.

37 And for Salpaad son of Opher there were no sons, but only daughters, and these are the names of the daughters of Salpaad: Mala and Noua and Egla and Melcha and Thersa.

38 These are the communities of Manasse from their muster, fifty-two thousand seven hundred.

39 And these are the sons of Ephraim: for Soutala, the community of Soutalai; for Tanach, the community of Tanachi.

40 These are the sons of Soutala: for Eden, the community of Edeni.

41 These are the communities of Ephraim from their muster, thirty-two thousand five hundred. – These are the communities of the sons of Joseph according to their communities.

42 The sons of Benjamin according to their communities: for Bale, the community of Balei; for Asyber, the community of Asyberi; for Jachiran, the community of Jachirani;

43 for Sophan, the community of Sophani.

44 And the sons of Bale were Adar and Noeman: for Adar, the community of Adari; for Noeman, the community of Noemani.

45 These are the sons of Benjamin according to their communities, from their muster, forty-five thousand six hundred.

46 And the sons of Dan according to their communities: for Sami, the community of Sami. These are the communities of Dan according to their communities.

47 All the communities of Sami, according to their muster, were sixty-four thousand four hundred.

48 The sons of Nephthali according to their communities: for Asiel, the community of Asieli; for Gauni, the community of Gauni;

49 for Jeser, the community of Jeseri; for Sellem, the community of Sellemi.

50 These are the communities of Nephthali from their muster, forty-five thousand four hundred.

51 This is the muster of the sons of Israel: six hundred one thousand seven hundred thirty.

52 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

53 To these the land shall be apportioned to inherit, from the number of names;

54 for the greater number you shall increase the inheritance, and for the lesser number you shall decrease their inheritance; to each one, according as they were mustered, their inheritance shall be given.

55 Through lots the land shall be apportioned; by the names according to the tribes of their paternal families they shall inherit;

56 from the lot you shall apportion their inheritance between many and few.

57 And the sons of Levi according to their communities: for Gedson, the community of Gedsoni; for Kaath, the community of Kaathi; for Merari, the community of Merari.

58 These are the communities of the sons of Levi: the community of Lobeni, the community of Chebroni, the community of Kore, and the community of Mousi. And Kaath begot Amram.

59 And the name of his wife was Jochabed, a daughter of Levi, who bore these to Levi in Egypt; and she bore to Amram Aaron and Moses and Mariam their sister.

60 And to Aaron were born Nadab and Abioud and Eleazar and Ithamar.

61 And Nadab and Abioud died when they themselves offered strange fire before the Lord in the wilderness of Sina.

62 And from their muster they were twenty-three thousand, every male from a month old and above; for they were not mustered together in the midst of the sons of Israel, because no allotment is given to them in the midst of the sons of Israel.

63 And this is the muster of Moses and Eleazar the priest, who mustered the sons of Israel in Araboth Moab by the Jordan opposite Jericho.

64 And among these there was not a man of those mustered by Moses and Aaron, whom they mustered, the sons of Israel, in the wilderness of Sina;

65 because the Lord said to them: By death they shall die in the wilderness. And not even one of them was left except Chaleb son of Jephonne and Jesus, the one of Nave.

Chapter 27

1 And the daughters of Salpaad son of Opher son of Galaad son of Machir, of the community of Manasse, of the sons of Joseph, approached [and these are their names: Mala and Noua and Egla and Melcha and Thersa],

2 and standing before Moses and before Eleazar the priest and before the rulers and before the entire congregation at the door of the tabernacle of testimony, they say:

3 Our father died in the wilderness, and he was not in the midst of the congregation that rose together against the Lord in the congregation of Kore, because he died through his own sin, and there were no sons for him.

4 Let the name of our father not be wiped out from the midst of his community, because there is no son for him. Give us a possession in the midst of our father’s brothers.

5 And Moses brought their judgment before the Lord.

6 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

7 The daughters of Salpaad have spoken correctly. As a gift you shall give them a possession of inheritance in the midst of their father’s brothers, and you shall place the allotment of their father upon them.

8 And you shall speak to the sons of Israel, saying: If a person dies and there is no son for him, you shall place his inheritance upon his daughter;

9 but if there is no daughter for him, you shall give the inheritance to his brother;

10 but if there are no brothers for him, you shall give the inheritance to the brother of his father;

11 but if there are no brothers of his father, you shall give the inheritance to the member of his household who is nearest to him from his tribe, and he shall inherit his things. And this shall be an ordinance of judgment for the sons of Israel, in the manner that the Lord instructed Moses.

12 And the Lord said to Moses: Go up into the mountain that is across [this is Mount Nabau], and see the land of Chanaan, which I am giving to the sons of Israel as a possession;

13 and you shall see it and shall be added to your people, you also, in the manner that Aaron your brother was added on Or the mountain,

14 because you transgressed my word in the wilderness of Sin, when the congregation opposed, to sanctify me; you did not sanctify me at the water before them [this is the water of contention of Cades in the wilderness of Sin].

15 And Moses said to the Lord:

16 Let the Lord, the God of the spirits and of all flesh, muster a man over this congregation,

17 who shall go out before their face and who shall enter before their face and who shall lead them out and who shall lead them in, and the congregation of the Lord shall not be like sheep for whom there is no shepherd.

18 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying: Take to yourself Jesus son of Nave, a man who has spirit in himself, and you shall place your hands upon him;

19 and you shall stand him before Eleazar the priest and shall command him before the entire congregation and shall command concerning him before them,

20 and you shall give some of your glory upon him, so that the sons of Israel may listen to him.

21 And he shall stand before Eleazar the priest, and they shall inquire of him concerning the judgment of the Manifestations before the Lord; at his mouth they shall go out, and at his mouth they shall enter, he and the sons of Israel with one accord and the entire congregation.

22 And Moses did in the manner that the Lord commanded him, and taking Jesus, he stood him before Eleazar the priest and before the entire congregation,

23 and he placed his hands upon him and appointed him, just as the Lord instructed Moses.

Chapter 28

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Command the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them, saying: My gifts, my given things, my offerings for an odor of sweetness, you shall carefully keep to offer to me at my festivals.

3 And you shall say to them: These are the offerings, as many as you shall bring to the Lord: two unblemished year-old lambs each day as a continual whole burnt offering;

4 you shall make the one lamb in the morning, and you shall make the second lamb toward evening;

5 and you shall make a tenth of an oiphi of fine flour as a sacrifice, worked with oil in a fourth of a hin.

6 It is a continual whole burnt offering, which was made on Mount Sina for an odor of sweetness to the Lord;

7 and its libation shall be a fourth of a hin for the one lamb; in the holy place you shall pour a libation of sikera to the Lord.

8 And you shall make the second lamb toward evening; according to its sacrifice and according to its libation you shall make it, for an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

9 And on the day of the Sabbaths you shall bring two unblemished year-old lambs and two-tenths of fine flour worked with oil as a sacrifice, and a libation;

10 a whole burnt offering of Sabbaths on the Sabbaths, upon the continual whole burnt offering and its libation.

11 And at the new moons you shall bring whole burnt offerings to the Lord: two calves from cattle and one ram, seven unblemished year-old lambs;

12 three-tenths of fine flour worked with oil for the one calf, and two-tenths of fine flour worked with oil for the one ram;

13 a tenth of fine flour worked with oil for the one lamb, a sacrifice, an odor of sweetness, an offering to the Lord.

14 Their libation shall be half of a hin for the one calf, and a third of a hin for the one ram, and a fourth of a hin of wine for the one lamb. This is a whole burnt offering, month from month, for the months of the year.

15 And one male kid from goats concerning sin to the Lord; upon the continual whole burnt offering it shall be made, and its libation.

16 And in the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, is Pascha to the Lord.

17 And on the fifteenth day of this month is a festival; for seven days you shall eat unleavened things.

18 And the first day shall be designated holy for you; you shall do no work of service.

19 And you shall bring whole burnt offerings, offerings to the Lord: two calves from cattle, one ram, seven year-old lambs; they shall be unblemished for you.

20 And their sacrifice shall be fine flour worked with oil, three-tenths for the one calf and two-tenths for the one ram;

21 a tenth, a tenth, you shall make for the one lamb, for the seven lambs;

22 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, to make atonement concerning you;

23 apart from the morning continual whole burnt offering, which is a continual whole burnt offering.

24 These things, according to these things, you shall make each day for the seven days, a gift, an offering for an odor of sweetness to the Lord; upon the continual whole burnt offering you shall make its libation.

25 And the seventh day shall be a holy convocation for you; you shall do no work of service on it.

26 And on the day of the new things of the weeks, when you present a new sacrifice to the Lord, it shall be designated holy for you; you shall do no work of service.

27 And you shall bring whole burnt offerings for an odor of sweetness to the Lord: two calves from cattle, one ram, seven unblemished year-old lambs;

28 their sacrifice shall be fine flour worked with oil, three-tenths for the one calf and two-tenths for the one ram;

29 a tenth, a tenth, for the one lamb, for the seven lambs;

30 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, to make atonement concerning you;

31 apart from the continual whole burnt offering; and you shall make their sacrifice for me – they shall be unblemished for you – and their libations.

Chapter 29

1 And in the seventh month, on the first of the month, it shall be designated holy for you; you shall do no work of service. It shall be a day of signaling for you.

2 And you shall make whole burnt offerings for an odor of sweetness to the Lord: one calf from cattle, one ram, seven unblemished year-old lambs;

3 their sacrifice shall be fine flour worked with oil, three-tenths for the one calf and two-tenths for the one ram;

4 a tenth, a tenth, for the one lamb, for the seven lambs;

5 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, to make atonement concerning you;

6 apart from the whole burnt offerings of the new moon, and their sacrifices and their libations, and the continual whole burnt offering and their sacrifices and their libations, according to their comparison, for an odor of sweetness to the Lord.

7 And on the tenth of this month it shall be designated holy for you, and you shall afflict your souls and shall do no work.

8 And you shall offer whole burnt offerings for an odor of sweetness, offerings to the Lord: one calf from cattle, one ram, seven year-old lambs; they shall be unblemished for you;

9 their sacrifice shall be fine flour worked with oil, three-tenths for the one calf and two-tenths for the one ram;

10 a tenth, a tenth, for the one lamb, for the seven lambs;

11 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, to make atonement concerning you; apart from the thing concerning the sin of atonement and the continual whole burnt offering, its sacrifice and its libation according to the comparison, for an odor of sweetness, an offering to the Lord.

12 And on the fifteenth day of this seventh month it shall be designated holy for you; you shall do no work of service, and you shall celebrate it as a festival to the Lord for seven days.

13 And you shall bring whole burnt offerings, offerings for an odor of sweetness to the Lord: on the first day, thirteen calves from cattle, two rams, fourteen year-old lambs; they shall be unblemished;

14 their sacrifices shall be fine flour worked with oil, three-tenths for the one calf, for the thirteen calves, and two-tenths for the one ram, for the two rams;

15 a tenth, a tenth, for the one lamb, for the fourteen lambs;

16 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

17 And on the second day: twelve calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

18 their sacrifice and their libation for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

19 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

20 On the third day: eleven calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

21 their sacrifice and their libation for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

22 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

23 On the fourth day: ten calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

24 their sacrifices and their libations for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

25 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

26 On the fifth day: nine calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

27 their sacrifices and their libations for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

28 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

29 On the sixth day: eight calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

30 their sacrifices and their libations for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

31 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

32 On the seventh day: seven calves, two rams, fourteen unblemished year-old lambs;

33 their sacrifices and their libations for the calves and for the rams and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

34 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations. –

35 And on the eighth day there shall be a closing for you; you shall do no work of service on it.

36 And you shall bring whole burnt offerings for an odor of sweetness, offerings to the Lord: one calf, one ram, seven unblemished year-old lambs;

37 their sacrifices and their libations for the calf and for the ram and for the lambs, according to their number, according to their comparison;

38 and one male kid from goats concerning sin, apart from the continual whole burnt offering; their sacrifices and their libations.

39 These things you shall make to the Lord at your festivals, apart from your vows and your voluntary offerings and your whole burnt offerings and your sacrifices and your libations and your salvations.

Chapter 30

1 And Moses spoke to the sons of Israel according to all the things that the Lord commanded Moses.

2 And Moses spoke to the rulers of the tribes of Israel, saying: This is the word that the Lord instructed:

3 A person, a person, who vows a vow to the Lord or swears an oath or determines a determination concerning his soul shall not profane his word; everything that comes out of his mouth he shall do.

4 But if a woman vows a vow to the Lord or determines a determination in the house of her father in her youth,

5 and her father hears her vows and her determinations that she determined against her soul, and her father remains silent toward her, then all her vows shall stand, and all the determinations that she determined against her soul shall remain for her.

6 But if her father refuses with a refusal on whatever day he hears all her vows and the determinations that she determined against her soul, they shall not stand; and the Lord shall purify her, because her father refused. –

7 But if she indeed becomes a man’s wife, and her vows are upon her according to the distinction of her lips, the determinations that she determined against her soul,

8 and her husband hears and remains silent toward her on whatever day he hears, then thus all her vows shall stand, and her determinations that she determined against her soul shall stand.

9 But if her husband refuses with a refusal on whatever day he hears, all her vows and her determinations that she determined against her soul shall not remain, because her husband refused them away from her; and the Lord shall purify her.

10 And the vow of a widow and of one cast out, as many things as she vows against her soul, shall remain for her. –

11 But if in the house of her husband her vow or the determination against her soul is with an oath,

12 and her husband hears and remains silent toward her and does not refuse her, then all her vows shall stand, and all her determinations that she determined against her soul shall stand against her.

13 But if her husband, removing, removes them on whatever day he hears, then everything that comes out from her lips according to her vows and according to the determinations against her soul shall not remain for her; her husband removed it, and the Lord shall purify her.

14 Every vow and every oath of a bond to afflict a soul, her husband shall cause to stand for her, and her husband shall remove.

15 But if, being silent, he remains silent toward her day from day, then he shall cause all her vows to stand for her and shall cause the determinations upon her to stand for her, because he was silent toward her on the day that he heard.

16 But if, removing, he removes them from her after the day on which he heard, then he shall receive his sin. –

17 These are the ordinances, as many as the Lord commanded Moses, between a man and his wife and between a father and a daughter in youth in a father’s house.

Chapter 31

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Avenge the vengeance of the sons of Israel from the Madianites, and afterward you shall be added to your people.

3 And Moses spoke to the people, saying: Arm men from among you to be arrayed before the Lord against Madian, to repay vengeance from the Lord to Madian.

4 A thousand from a tribe, a thousand from a tribe, from all the tribes of Israel you shall send to be arrayed.

5 And from the thousands of Israel they numbered out a thousand from a tribe, twelve thousand armed for battle array.

6 And Moses sent them, a thousand from a tribe, a thousand from a tribe, with their force, and Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the priest; and the holy vessels and the trumpets of the signals were in their hands.

7 And they arrayed themselves against Madian, just as the Lord commanded Moses, and they killed every male.

8 And they killed the kings of Madian together with their wounded: Evin and Sour and Rokom and Our and Robok, five kings of Madian; and Balaam son of Beor they killed by broadsword together with their wounded.

9 And they plundered the women of Madian and their equipment, and they plundered their livestock and all their acquired possessions and their force.

10 And all their cities, the ones in their houses, and their farmsteads they burned with fire.

11 And they took all the plunder and all their spoils, from human to livestock,

12 and they brought the captivity and the spoils and the plunder to Moses and to Eleazar the priest and to all the sons of Israel, to the camp at Araboth Moab, which is on the Jordan opposite Jericho.

13 And Moses and Eleazar the priest and all the rulers of the congregation went out to meet them outside the camp.

14 And Moses became angry with the overseers of the force, the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds who were coming from the battle array of the war,

15 and Moses said to them: Why did you keep every female alive?

16 For these were the ones who, according to the word of Balaam, caused the sons of Israel to revolt and overlook the word of the Lord because of Phogor, and the blow came among the congregation of the Lord.

17 And now kill every male in the entire company, and kill every woman who has known a male’s bed.

18 But keep alive the entire company of the women who have not known a male’s bed.

19 And you, camp outside the camp for seven days. Everyone who killed and who touches the wounded one shall be purified on the third day and on the seventh day, you and your captivity.

20 And every covering and every leather vessel and every work made from goat and every wooden vessel you shall purify.

21 And Eleazar the priest said to the men of the force who were coming from the battle array of the war: This is the ordinance of the law that the Lord prescribed to Moses:

22 except for the gold and the silver and bronze and iron and lead and tin,

23 every thing that shall pass through fire shall also be cleansed; but rather, it shall be purified with the water of purification. And all things that do not pass through fire shall pass through water.

24 And you shall wash your garments on the seventh day and shall be cleansed, and after these things you shall enter into the camp.

25 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

26 Take the head-count of the spoils of the captivity, from human to livestock, you and Eleazar the priest and the rulers of the paternal families of the congregation,

27 and you shall divide the spoils between the warriors who go out into the battle array and between the entire congregation.

28 And you shall remove a tribute for the Lord from the warrior men who have gone out into the battle array: one soul from five hundred, from the humans and from the livestock and from the cattle and from the sheep and from the goats.

29 And from their half you shall take it, and you shall give the first produce of the Lord to Eleazar the priest.

30 And from the half belonging to the sons of Israel you shall take one from the fifty, from the humans and from the cattle and from the sheep and from the donkeys and from all the livestock, and you shall give them to the Levites who keep the watches in the tent of the Lord.

31 And Moses and Eleazar the priest did just as the Lord prescribed to Moses.

32 And the surplus of the plunder that the warrior men plundered was, from the sheep, six hundred seventy-five thousand,

33 and seventy-two thousand cattle,

34 and sixty-one thousand donkeys,

35 and human souls from the women who had not known a man’s bed, all the souls, thirty-two thousand.

36 And the half share, the portion of those who had gone out to the war, was, from the number of the sheep, three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred,

37 and the tribute for the Lord from the sheep was six hundred seventy-five;

38 and the cattle were thirty-six thousand, and the tribute for the Lord, seventy-two;

39 and the donkeys, thirty thousand five hundred, and the tribute for the Lord, sixty-one;

40 and the human souls, sixteen thousand, and their tribute for the Lord, thirty-two souls.

41 And Moses gave the tribute for the Lord, the removal offering of God, to Eleazar the priest, just as the Lord prescribed to Moses.

42 From the half share of the sons of Israel, whom Moses divided from the warrior men –

43 and the half share belonging to the congregation was, from the sheep, three hundred thirty-seven thousand five hundred,

44 and thirty-six thousand cattle,

45 thirty thousand five hundred donkeys,

46 and sixteen thousand human souls –

47 and Moses took from the half share of the sons of Israel the one from the fifty, from the humans and from the livestock, and gave them to the Levites who keep the watches of the tent of the Lord, in the manner that the Lord prescribed to Moses.

48 And all those appointed over the thousands of the force, commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, approached Moses,

49 and they said to Moses: Your servants have taken the head-count of the warrior men who are with us, and not even one of them has been missing.

50 And we have brought the gift for the Lord, each man what he found, a gold vessel: anklet and bracelet and ring and armlet and braided ornament, to make atonement for us before the Lord.

51 And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold from them, every worked vessel.

52 And all the gold, the removal offering that they removed for the Lord, was sixteen thousand seven hundred fifty shekels, from the commanders of thousands and from the commanders of hundreds.

53 And the warrior men each plundered for himself.

54 And Moses and Eleazar the priest took the gold from the commanders of thousands and from the commanders of hundreds and brought them into the tent of the testimony as a memorial of the sons of Israel before the Lord.

Chapter 32

1 And the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad had a multitude of livestock, a very great multitude; and they saw the region of Jazer and the region of Galaad, and the place was a place for livestock.

2 And the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad approached and said to Moses and to Eleazar the priest and to the rulers of the congregation, saying:

3 Ataroth and Daibon and Jazer and Nambra and Esebon and Eleale and Sebama and Nabau and Baian,

4 the land that the Lord delivered before the sons of Israel, is livestock-feeding land, and your servants possess livestock.

5 And they said: If we have found favor before you, let this land be given to your household servants as a possession, and do not take us across the Jordan.

6 And Moses said to the sons of Gad and to the sons of Reuben: Your brothers are going to war, and will you sit here?

7 And why do you turn aside the minds of the sons of Israel so that they do not cross over into the land that the Lord is giving them?

8 Did your fathers not do so when I sent them from Cades Barne to observe the land?

9 And they went up to the Ravine of the Cluster and observed the land, and they turned away the heart of the sons of Israel so that they would not enter into the land that the Lord gave them.

10 And the Lord became angry with fury on that day and swore, saying:

11 These men who came up from Egypt, from twenty years old and above, those knowing evil and good, surely shall not see the land that I swore to Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, for they did not follow after me,

12 except Chaleb son of Jephonne, the one separated, and Jesus, the one of Nave, because he followed after the Lord.

13 And the Lord became angry with fury against Israel and made them whirl about in the wilderness for forty years, until the entire generation, those doing wicked things before the Lord, was completely consumed.

14 Behold, you rose up in place of your fathers, a band of sinful men, to add still more to the fury of the wrath of the Lord against Israel,

15 because you will turn away from him, to add still more to leave him in the wilderness, and you will act lawlessly against this entire congregation.

16 And they approached him and said: Let us build sheep farmsteads here for our livestock and cities for our equipment,

17 and we will be armed as a vanguard ahead of the sons of Israel until we bring them to their own place; and our equipment shall dwell in walled cities because of those who inhabit the land.

18 We certainly shall not return to our houses until the sons of Israel have each been apportioned into his inheritance.

19 And we shall no longer inherit among them from across the Jordan and beyond, because we hold our allotments beyond the Jordan in the east.

20 And Moses said to them: If you act according to this word, if you arm yourselves before the Lord for war,

21 and every armed man of yours passes over the Jordan before the Lord until his enemy is destroyed from before his face,

22 and the land is brought under mastery before the Lord, then after these things you shall return and shall be innocent before the Lord and from Israel, and this land shall be yours as a possession before the Lord.

23 But if you do not act in this way, you shall sin before the Lord, and you shall know your sin when evils overtake you.

24 And you shall build for yourselves cities for your equipment and farmsteads for your livestock, and you shall do what proceeds from your mouth.

25 And the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad spoke to Moses, saying: Your servants shall do just as our lord commands.

26 Our equipment and our wives and all our livestock shall be in the cities of Galaad,

27 but your servants shall all pass over, armed and arrayed before the Lord for war, in the manner that our lord says.

28 And Moses appointed to them Eleazar the priest and Jesus son of Nave and the rulers of the paternal families of the tribes of Israel.

29 And Moses said to them: If the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad pass over the Jordan with you, every one armed for war before the Lord, and you gain mastery over the land before you, then you shall give them the land of Galaad as a possession.

30 But if they do not pass over armed with you for war before the Lord, then you shall take their equipment and their wives and their livestock across ahead of you into the land of Chanaan, and they shall be made co-inheritors among you in the land of Chanaan.

31 And the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad answered, saying: As many things as the Lord says to his attendants, so shall we do.

32 We shall cross over armed before the Lord into the land of Chanaan, and you shall give us the possession beyond the Jordan.

33 And Moses gave to them, to the sons of Gad and to the sons of Reuben and to half the tribe of Manasse of the sons of Joseph, the kingdom of Seon king of the Amorrites and the kingdom of Og king of Basan, the land and the cities with its borders, cities of the land round about.

34 And the sons of Gad built Daibon and Ataroth and Aroer,

35 and Sophar and Jazer, and they raised them up,

36 and Nambra and Baitharan, strong cities and sheep farmsteads. –

37 And the sons of Reuben built Esebon and Eleale and Kariathaim,

38 and Beelmeon, encircled cities, and Sebama; and they named the names of the cities that they built according to their names. –

39 And a son of Machir son of Manasse went to Galaad and took it and destroyed the Amorrite who inhabited it.

40 And Moses gave Galaad to Machir son of Manasse, and he dwelt there.

41 And Jair, the one of Manasse, went and took their farmsteads and named them Farmsteads of Jair.

42 And Nabau went and took Kanaath and its villages and named them Naboth from his own name.

Chapter 33

1 And these are the stations of the sons of Israel, as they went out from the land of Egypt with their force by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

2 And Moses wrote down their departures and their stations through the word of the Lord, and these are the stations of their journey.

3 They departed from Ramesses in the first month, on the fifteenth day of the first month. On the day after the Pascha, the sons of Israel went out with hand held high before all the Egyptians,

4 while the Egyptians were burying from among themselves all the dead whom the Lord struck, every firstborn in the land of Egypt; and among their gods the Lord carried out the vengeance.

5 And the sons of Israel departed from Ramesses and encamped at Sokchoth.

6 And they departed from Sokchoth and encamped at Bouthan, which is some part of the wilderness.

7 And they departed from Bouthan and encamped at the mouth of Eiroth, which is opposite Beelsepphon, and they encamped opposite Magdol.

8 And they departed from opposite Eiroth and crossed through the middle of the sea into the wilderness, and they themselves traveled a road of three days through the wilderness and encamped at Pikriai.

9 And they departed from Pikriai and came to Ailim; and in Ailim were twelve springs of waters and seventy trunks of palm trees, and they encamped there beside the water.

10 And they departed from Ailim and encamped at Red Sea.

11 And they departed from Red Sea and encamped in the wilderness of Sin.

12 And they departed from the wilderness of Sin and encamped at Raphaka.

13 And they departed from Raphaka and encamped at Ailous.

14 And they departed from Ailous and encamped at Raphidin, and there was no water there for the people to drink.

15 And they departed from Raphidin and encamped in the wilderness of Sina.

16 And they departed from the wilderness of Sina and encamped at Memorials of Desire.

17 And they departed from Memorials of Desire and encamped at Aseroth.

18 And they departed from Aseroth and encamped at Rathama.

19 And they departed from Rathama and encamped at Remmon Phares.

20 And they departed from Remmon Phares and encamped at Lemona.

21 And they departed from Lemona and encamped at Dessa.

22 And they departed from Dessa and encamped at Makellath.

23 And they departed from Makellath and encamped at Saphar.

24 And they departed from Saphar and encamped at Charadath.

25 And they departed from Charadath and encamped at Makeloth.

26 And they departed from Makeloth and encamped at Kataath.

27 And they departed from Kataath and encamped at Tarath.

28 And they departed from Tarath and encamped at Matekka.

29 And they departed from Matekka and encamped at Selmona.

30 And they departed from Selmona and encamped at Massourouth.

31 And they departed from Massourouth and encamped at Banaia.

32 And they departed from Banaia and encamped at Mount Gadgad.

33 And they departed from Mount Gadgad and encamped at Etebatha.

34 And they departed from Etebatha and encamped at Ebrona.

35 And they departed from Ebrona and encamped at Gesiongaber.

36 And they departed from Gesiongaber and encamped in the wilderness of Sin. And they departed from the wilderness of Sin and encamped in the wilderness of Pharan; this is Cades.

37 And they departed from Cades and encamped at Or the mountain, near the land of Edom.

38 And Aaron the priest went up by the command of the Lord and died there in the fortieth year of the exodus of the sons of Israel from the land of Egypt, in the fifth month, on the first of the month.

39 And Aaron was one hundred twenty-three years old when he was dying at Or the mountain.

40 And Chananis king of Arad heard, and this one dwelt in the land of Chanaan, when the sons of Israel were entering.

41 And they departed from Or the mountain and encamped at Selmona.

42 And they departed from Selmona and encamped at Phino.

43 And they departed from Phino and encamped at Oboth.

44 And they departed from Oboth and encamped at Gai, across at the borders of Moab.

45 And they departed from Gai and encamped at Daibon Gad.

46 And they departed from Daibon Gad and encamped at Gelmon Deblathaim.

47 And they departed from Gelmon Deblathaim and encamped at the mountains of Abarim opposite Nabau.

48 And they departed from the mountains of Abarim and encamped at the west of Moab beside the Jordan opposite Jericho,

49 and they encamped beside the Jordan between Aisimoth and Belsattim, toward the west of Moab.

50 And the Lord spoke to Moses at the west of Moab beside the Jordan opposite Jericho, saying:

51 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: You are crossing over the Jordan into the land of Chanaan,

52 and you shall destroy all those who inhabit the land before your face, and you shall remove their watch-posts, and all their cast images you shall destroy, and all their pillars you shall remove.

53 And you shall destroy all those who inhabit the land and shall dwell in it, for I have given their land to you as an allotment.

54 And you shall inherit their land by allotment according to your tribes. For those who are more, you shall increase their possession, and for those who are fewer, you shall decrease their possession. Wherever his name goes out there, it shall be his; according to the tribes of your paternal families you shall inherit.

55 But if you do not destroy those who inhabit the land from before your face, then those whom you leave from among them shall be thorns in your eyes and darts in your sides, and they shall be hostile on the land upon which you dwell.

56 And it shall be that, just as I had determined to do to them, I shall do to you.

Chapter 34

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

2 Command the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: You are entering into the land of Chanaan. This shall be for you as an inheritance: the land of Chanaan with its borders.

3 And your side toward southwest shall be from the wilderness of Sin as far as what adjoins Edom, and your borders toward southwest shall be from part of the Salt Sea, from east.

4 And the borders shall go around you from southwest toward the Ascent of Akrabin and shall pass Senna, and its outlet shall be southwest of Cades Barne, and it shall go out to the farmstead of Arad and shall pass Asemona.

5 And the border shall turn around from Asemona to the winter-stream of Egypt, and its outlet shall be the sea.

6 And the borders of the sea shall be for you. The Great Sea shall define; this shall be for you the borders of the sea.

7 And this shall be the borders for you toward north: from the Great Sea you shall measure out for yourselves beside the mountain, the mountain.

8 And from the mountain, the mountain, you shall measure out for them as they enter into Emath, and its outlet shall be the borders of Sarada.

9 And the borders shall go out to Dephrona, and its outlet shall be Asernain; this shall be borders for you from north.

10 And you shall measure out for yourselves the borders of the east from Asernain to Sepphama.

11 And the border shall descend from Seppham to Arbela, from east, to the springs; and the border shall descend to Bela upon the back of Sea Chenara from east.

12 And the border shall descend to the Jordan, and its outlet shall be the Salt Sea. This shall be the land for you and its borders round about.

13 And Moses commanded the sons of Israel, saying: This is the land that you shall inherit by lot, in the manner that the Lord prescribed to Moses to give it to the nine tribes and to half the tribe of Manasse.

14 For the tribe of the sons of Reuben and the tribe of the sons of Gad took according to the houses of their paternal families, and half the tribe of Manasse received their allotments.

15 Two tribes and half a tribe took their allotments beyond the Jordan opposite Jericho, from south toward east.

16 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

17 These are the names of the men who shall inherit the land for you: Eleazar the priest and Jesus, the one of Nave.

18 And you shall take one ruler from a tribe to apportion the land for you.

19 And these are the names of the men: from the tribe of Judas, Chaleb son of Jephonne;

20 from the tribe of Symeon, Salamiel son of Emioud;

21 from the tribe of Benjamin, Eldad son of Chaslon;

22 from the tribe of Dan, the ruler Bakchir son of Egli;

23 from the sons of Joseph, from the tribe of the sons of Manasse, the ruler Aniel son of Ouphi;

24 from the tribe of the sons of Ephraim, the ruler Kamouel son of Sabatha;

25 from the tribe of Zaboulon, the ruler Elisaphan son of Pharnach;

26 from the tribe of the sons of Issachar, the ruler Phaltiel son of Oza;

27 from the tribe of the sons of Aser, the ruler Achior son of Selemi;

28 from the tribe of Nephthali, the ruler Phadael son of Benamioud.

29 These are the ones whom the Lord commanded to apportion for the sons of Israel in the land of Chanaan.

Chapter 35

1 And the Lord spoke to Moses at the west of Moab beside the Jordan opposite Jericho, saying:

2 Prescribe to the sons of Israel, and they shall give to the Levites, from the allotments of their possession, cities to dwell in; and they shall give the suburbs of the cities around them to the Levites.

3 And the cities shall be for them to dwell in, and their separations shall be for their livestock and for all their quadrupeds.

4 And the things adjoining the cities that you shall give to the Levites shall be from the wall of the city and outward two thousand cubits around.

5 And you shall measure outside the city the side toward east, two thousand cubits, and the side toward southwest, two thousand cubits, and the side toward the sea, two thousand cubits, and the side toward north, two thousand cubits; and the city shall be in the middle of this for you, and the neighboring lands of the cities.

6 And the cities you shall give to the Levites shall be the six cities of exile, which you shall give for the one who killed to flee there, and besides these, forty-two cities.

7 All the cities you shall give to the Levites shall be forty-eight cities, these and their suburbs.

8 And the cities that you shall give from the possession of the sons of Israel: from those with many, many, and from the lesser, fewer. Each, according to his inheritance that they shall inherit, they shall give from the cities to the Levites.

9 And the Lord spoke to Moses, saying:

10 Speak to the sons of Israel, and you shall say to them: You are crossing over the Jordan into the land of Chanaan,

11 and you shall distinguish cities for yourselves. They shall be exile places for you, for the killer to flee there, everyone who struck a soul involuntarily.

12 And the cities shall be exile places for you from the one acting as kinsman for the blood, and the one who kills shall certainly not die until he stands before the congregation for judgment.

13 And the cities that you shall give, the six cities, shall be exile places for you.

14 You shall give the three cities beyond the Jordan, and you shall give the three cities in the land of Chanaan.

15 It shall be a place of exile for the sons of Israel, and for the proselyte and the sojourner among you these cities shall be as an exile place, for everyone who struck a soul involuntarily to flee there. –

16 But if he strikes him with an iron implement and he comes to an end, he is a killer; by death let the killer be put to death.

17 But if with a stone from a hand, by which he will die in it, he strikes him, and he dies, he is a killer; by death let the killer be put to death.

18 But if with a wooden implement from a hand, by which he will die in it, he strikes him, and he dies, he is a killer; by death let the killer be put to death.

19 The one acting as kinsman for the blood, this one shall kill the one who killed; whenever he meets him, this one shall kill him.

20 But if through hatred he pushes him and throws upon him any implement from ambush, and he dies,

21 or through anger he struck him with the hand, and he dies, by death let the one who struck be put to death; he is a killer. By death let the one who kills be put to death. The one acting as kinsman for the blood shall kill the one who killed when he meets him. –

22 But if suddenly, not through hatred, he pushes him, or throws upon him any implement, not from ambush,

23 or with any stone by which he will die in it, without knowing, and it falls upon him, and he dies, though he was not his enemy nor was seeking to harm him,

24 then the congregation shall judge between the one who struck and between the one acting as kinsman for the blood according to these judgments.

25 And the congregation shall rescue the one who killed from the one acting as kinsman for the blood, and they, the congregation, shall restore him to the city of his place of exile, where he had fled, and he shall dwell there until the great priest whom they anointed with the holy oil dies.

26 But if the one who killed goes out by an exit beyond the borders of the city into which he fled there,

27 and the one acting as kinsman for the blood finds him outside the borders of his city of refuge, and the one acting as kinsman for the blood kills the one who killed, he is not liable.

28 For let him dwell in the city of refuge until the great priest dies, and after the great priest dies, the one who killed shall return to the land of his possession.

29 And these things shall be for you as an ordinance of judgment for your generations in all your dwellings. –

30 Everyone who struck a soul: through witnesses you shall kill the one who killed, and one witness shall not testify against a soul for it to die.

31 And you shall not take ransom concerning a soul from the one who killed, who is liable to be killed; for by death he shall be put to death.

32 You shall not take ransom for fleeing into a city of exile places, to dwell again upon the land, until the great priest dies.

33 And you shall certainly not murder the land in which you dwell; for this blood murders the land, and the land shall not be atoned from the blood shed upon it except upon the blood of the one shedding it.

34 And you shall not defile the land upon which you dwell, upon which I shall encamp among you; for I am the Lord encamping in the midst of the sons of Israel.

Chapter 36

1 And the rulers of the tribe of the sons of Galaad son of Machir son of Manasse, from the tribe of the sons of Joseph, approached and spoke before Moses and before Eleazar the priest and before the rulers of the houses of the paternal families of the sons of Israel,

2 and they said: The Lord commanded our lord to assign the land of the inheritance by allotment to the sons of Israel, and the Lord prescribed to our lord to give the inheritance of Salpaad our brother to his daughters.

3 And they shall become wives to one of the tribes of the sons of Israel, and their allotment shall be removed from the possession of our fathers and shall be added to the inheritance of the tribe to whom they become wives, and it shall be removed from the allotment of our inheritance.

4 But if the release of the sons of Israel comes, then their inheritance shall be added upon the inheritance of the tribe to whom they become wives, and their inheritance shall be removed from the inheritance of the tribe of our paternal family.

5 And Moses commanded the sons of Israel by the command of the Lord, saying: Thus the tribe of the sons of Joseph say.

6 This is the word that the Lord prescribed to the daughters of Salpaad, saying: Where it is pleasing before them, let them become wives; only from the community of their father let them become wives,

7 and an inheritance for the sons of Israel shall not be turned around from tribe to tribe, because the sons of Israel shall each be joined in the inheritance of the tribe of his paternal family.

8 And every daughter acting as next-of-kin to an inheritance from the tribes of the sons of Israel shall become a wife to one from the community of her father, so that the sons of Israel may each act as next-of-kin to his paternal inheritance.

9 And an allotment shall not be turned around from a tribe to another tribe, but the sons of Israel shall each be joined in his inheritance.

10 In the manner that the Lord prescribed to Moses, thus the daughters of Salpaad did,

11 and Thersa and Egla and Melcha and Noua and Maala, daughters of Salpaad, became wives to their cousins.

12 From the community of Manasse of the sons of Joseph they became wives, and their inheritance came upon the tribe of the community of their father.

13 These are the commandments and the ordinances and the judgments that the Lord commanded by the hand of Moses at the west of Moab on the Jordan opposite Jericho.

Deuteronomy

Chapter 1

1 These are the words that Moses spoke to all Israel beyond the Jordan, in the wilderness toward the west near the Red Sea, between Pharan, Tophol and Lobon and Aulon and Katachrysea.

2 An eleven-days’ road in Choreb, toward Mount Seir, as far as Cades Barne.

3 And it happened in the fortieth year, in the eleventh month, on the first of the month, Moses spoke to all the sons of Israel according to all the things that the Lord commanded him for them,

4 after striking Seon king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Esebon, and Og king of Basan, who dwelt in Astaroth and in Edrain.

5 Beyond the Jordan in the land of Moab, Moses began to make this law clear, saying:

6 The Lord our God spoke to us in Choreb, saying: Let it be sufficient for you to dwell on this mountain.

7 Turn and set out, you, and enter into the mountain of the Amorrites and toward all those dwelling around Araba, into the mountain and the plain and toward the southwest and the coast, the land of the Chananites and Antilibanus, as far as the great river Euphrates.

8 See, I have delivered the land before you. Enter and inherit the land that I swore to your fathers, Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, to give to them and to their seed after them.

9 And I spoke to you at that time, saying: I shall not be able to bear you alone.

10 The Lord your God multiplied you, and behold, today you are like the stars of heaven in multitude.

11 May the Lord, the God of your fathers, add to you as you are, a thousandfold, and bless you, just as he spoke to you.

12 How shall I be able to bear alone your toil and your substance and your disputes?

13 Give yourselves men who are wise and knowledgeable and understanding for your tribes, and I shall appoint them over you as your leaders.

14 And you answered me and said: The word that you spoke to do is good.

15 And I took from you men who were wise and knowledgeable and understanding and appointed them to lead over you as commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds and commanders of fifties and commanders of tens and document-introducers for your judges.

16 And I commanded your judges at that time, saying: Hear thoroughly between your brothers, and judge justly between a man and between his brother and between his proselyte.

17 You shall not recognize a face in judgment; according to the small and according to the great you shall judge. You shall certainly not shrink from a person’s face, because the judgment is God’s. And the matter that may be hard for you, you shall bring up to me, and I shall hear it.

18 And I commanded you at that time all the words that you shall do.

19 And setting out from Choreb, we traveled through all that great and fearful wilderness that you saw, by the road of the mountain of the Amorrite, just as the Lord our God commanded us, and we came as far as Cades Barne.

20 And I said to you: You have come as far as the mountain of the Amorrite, which the Lord our God is giving you.

21 See, the Lord your God has delivered the land to you before your face. Go up and inherit it, in the manner that the Lord, the God of your fathers, said to you. Do not fear or be cowardly.

22 And you all approached me and said: Let us send men ahead of us, and let them survey the land for us and report to us an answer, the road by which we shall go up in it and the cities into which we shall enter.

23 And the word was pleasing before me, and I took from you twelve men, one man for each tribe.

24 And turning, they went up into the mountain and came as far as the Ravine of the Cluster and spied it out.

25 And they took in their hands some of the fruit of the land and brought it down to us and said: The land that the Lord our God is giving us is good.

26 And you were not willing to go up, and you disobeyed the word of the Lord your God,

27 and you murmured in your tents and said: Because the Lord hates us, he brought us out from the land of Egypt to hand us into the hands of the Amorrites, to utterly destroy us.

28 Where are we going up? Your brothers turned away your heart, saying: A great and numerous nation, and more powerful than us, and great cities walled as far as heaven; but we also saw sons of giants there.

29 And I said to you: Do not be terrified or be afraid of them.

30 The Lord your God, the one going before your face, he shall fight them together with you according to all the things that he did for you in the land of Egypt

31 and in this wilderness that you saw, how the Lord your God nourished you, as a person would nourish his son, along all the road that you traveled until you came to this place.

32 And in this word you did not put trust in the Lord your God,

33 who goes ahead of you on the road to choose a place for you, guiding you by fire at night, showing you the road upon which you go, and by a cloud by day.

34 And the Lord heard the voice of your words and, being provoked, swore, saying:

35 Surely no one of these men shall see this good land that I swore to their fathers,

36 except Chaleb son of Jephonne; he shall see it, and to him and to his sons I shall give the land upon which he stepped, because he was attached to the things toward the Lord.

37 And the Lord was enraged at me because of you, saying: Not even you shall certainly enter there.

38 Jesus son of Nave, who stands beside you, he shall enter there. Strengthen him, because he shall cause Israel to inherit it.

39 And every young child who today does not know good or evil, these shall enter there, and to these I shall give it, and they shall inherit it.

40 And you, turn and encamp in the wilderness by the road at the Red Sea.

41 And you answered me and said: We sinned before the Lord our God; we, going up, shall wage war according to all the things that the Lord our God commanded us. And each taking up his implements of war and gathering together, you were going up into the mountain.

42 And the Lord said to me: Say to them: You shall not go up, nor shall you wage war, for I am not with you; and you shall certainly not be crushed before your enemies.

43 And I spoke to you, and you did not listen to me, and you transgressed the word of the Lord and, forcing your way, went up into the mountain.

44 And the Amorrite who dwelt on that mountain went out to meet you, and they pursued you as if the bees might do, and they were wounding you from Seir as far as Herma.

45 And sitting down, you wept before the Lord, and the Lord did not listen to your voice or pay attention to you.

46 And you sat in Cades many days, as many days as you ever sat.

Chapter 2

1 And turning, we departed into the wilderness by the road toward Red Sea, in the manner that the Lord spoke to me, and we went around Mount Seir for many days.

2 And the Lord said to me:

3 Let it be sufficient for you to go around this mountain; therefore turn toward north.

4 And command the people, saying: You are passing by through the borders of your brothers, the sons of Esau, who dwell in Seir, and they shall fear you and shall be very wary of you.

5 Do not join war against them, for I shall certainly not give you any of their land, not even a step of a foot, because I have given Mount Seir to the sons of Esau as an allotment.

6 Buy foods from them for silver and eat, and you shall take water by measure from them for silver and drink.

7 For the Lord our God blessed you in every work of your hands. Know thoroughly how you passed through that great and fearful wilderness. Behold, for forty years the Lord your God has been with you; you did not lack a thing. –

8 And we passed by our brothers, the sons of Esau who dwell in Seir, along the road of Araba from Ailon and from Gasiongaber; and turning, we passed by the road through the wilderness of Moab.

9 And the Lord said to me: Do not be hostile toward the Moabites, and do not join war against them, for I shall certainly not give you any of their land as an allotment, because I have given Seir to the sons of Lot to inherit.

10 [The Ommin formerly sat upon it, a great and numerous nation, and strong like the Enakim.

11 They also shall be reckoned as Raphain like the Enakim, and the Moabites name them Ommin.

12 And in Seir the Chorraean formerly sat, and the sons of Esau destroyed them and wiped them out from their face and settled in their place, in the manner that Israel did to the land of his inheritance, which the Lord gave them.]

13 Now therefore rise and set out, you, and pass by the Ravine of Zaret. And we passed by the Ravine of Zaret.

14 And the days in which we traveled from Cades Barne until we passed by the Ravine of Zaret were thirty-eight years, until the entire generation of warrior men fell away dying from the camp, just as God swore to them.

15 And the hand of God was upon them to utterly consume them from the camp, until they fell away. –

16 And it happened when all the warrior men had fallen away dying from the midst of the people,

17 that the Lord spoke to me, saying:

18 You shall pass today by the borders of Moab, Seir,

19 and you shall draw near to the sons of Amman. Do not be hostile toward them, and do not join them in war, for I shall certainly not give you any of the land of the sons of Amman as an allotment, because I have given it to the sons of Lot as an allotment.

20 [It shall be reckoned as a land of Raphain, for the Raphain also formerly dwelt upon it, and the Ammanites name them Zomzommin,

21 a great and numerous nation, and more powerful than you, like the Enakim; and the Lord destroyed them before their face, and they inherited and settled in their place until this day,

22 just as they did for the sons of Esau who dwell in Seir, in the manner that they wiped out the Chorraean from their face and inherited and settled in their place until this day.

23 And the Evaites who dwelt in Aseroth as far as Gaza, and the Cappadocians who came out of Cappadocia, wiped them out and settled in their place.]

24 Now therefore rise and set out and pass by the Ravine of Arnon, you. Behold, I have delivered into your hands Seon king of Esebon, the Amorrite, and his land. Begin to inherit; join war against him.

25 On this day begin to give your trembling and your fear upon the face of all the nations beneath heaven, who, when they hear your name, shall be troubled and shall have birth pangs from your face.

26 And I sent envoys from the wilderness of Kedamoth to Seon king of Esebon with peaceable words, saying:

27 I shall pass through your land; on the road I shall pass. I shall not turn aside right or left.

28 You shall give me food for silver, and I shall eat, and you shall give me water for silver, and I shall drink; only that I shall pass through on foot,

29 just as the sons of Esau who dwell in Seir and the Moabites who dwell in Aroer did for me, until I cross the Jordan into the land that the Lord our God is giving us.

30 And Seon king of Esebon was not willing to let us pass through him, because the Lord our God hardened his spirit and strengthened his heart so that he might be delivered into your hands, as on this day.

31 And the Lord said to me: Behold, I have begun to deliver before your face Seon king of Esebon, the Amorrite, and his land. Begin to inherit his land.

32 And Seon king of Esebon went out to meet us, he and all his people, for war at Jassa.

33 And the Lord our God delivered him before our face, and we struck him and his sons and all his people,

34 and we took control of all his cities at that time and utterly destroyed every city in succession and their women and their children; we left no living captive.

35 Except the livestock we plundered, and we took the spoils of the cities.

36 From Aroer, which is beside the lip of the winter-stream Arnon, and the city that is in the ravine, and as far as the mountain of Galaad, there was no city that escaped us; the Lord our God delivered them all into our hands.

37 But we did not approach the land of the sons of Ammon, all the things adjoining the winter-stream Jabok and the cities in the hill country, just as the Lord our God commanded us. –

Chapter 3

1 And turning, we went up by the road into Basan, and Og king of Basan went out to meet us, he and all his people, for war at Edrain.

2 And the Lord said to me: Do not fear him, because I have delivered him and all his people and all his land into your hands, and you shall do to him as you did to Seon king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Esebon.

3 And the Lord our God delivered him into our hands, Og king of Basan and all his people, and we struck him until no seed of his was left.

4 And we took control of all his cities at that time; there was no city that we did not take from them: sixty cities, all the country around Argob of the kingdom of Og in Basan,

5 all fortified cities, high walls, gates and bars, apart from the very many cities of the Pherezites.

6 We utterly destroyed them, as we did to Seon king of Esebon, and we utterly destroyed every city in succession and the women and the children.

7 And all the livestock and the spoils of the cities we plundered for ourselves.

8 And at that time we took from the hands of the two kings of the Amorrites the land that was beyond the Jordan, from the winter-stream Arnon and as far as Aermon

9 [the Phoenicians name Aermon Sanior, and the Amorrite named it Sanir],

10 all the cities of Misor and all Galaad and all Basan as far as Selcha and Edrain, cities of the kingdom of Og in Basan.

11 Because only Og king of Basan was left from the Raphain. Behold, his bed was an iron bed; behold, it is at the citadel of the sons of Ammon, nine cubits its length and four cubits its width, by the cubit of a man.

12 And we inherited that land at that time. From Aroer, which is on the lip of the winter-stream Arnon, and half of Mount Galaad and its cities I gave to Reuben and to Gad.

13 And the remainder of Galaad and all Basan, the kingdom of Og, I gave to half the tribe of Manasse, and all the country around Argob, all that Basan; it shall be reckoned as land of Raphain.

14 And Jair son of Manasse took all the country around Argob as far as the borders of Gergasi and Omachathi; he named them after his name, Basan Auoth Jair, until this day.

15 And to Machir I gave Galaad.

16 And to Reuben and to Gad I have given from Galaad as far as the winter-stream Arnon [the middle of the winter-stream is a border] and as far as Jabok; the winter-stream is a border for the sons of Amman.

17 And Araba and the Jordan are a border of Machanareth and as far as the Sea of Araba, the Salt Sea, under Asedoth Phasga toward east. –

18 And I commanded you at that time, saying: The Lord your God gave you this land as an allotment. Armed, go ahead before the face of your brothers, the sons of Israel, every powerful man.

19 Except your wives and your children and your livestock – I know that you have much livestock – let them dwell in your cities that I gave you,

20 until the Lord your God gives your brothers rest as also you, and these also shall inherit the land that the Lord our God is giving them beyond the Jordan, and you shall each return to his inheritance that I gave you.

21 And I commanded Jesus at that time, saying: Your eyes have seen all the things that the Lord our God did to these two kings; thus the Lord our God shall do to all the kingdoms upon which you cross there.

22 You shall not fear, because the Lord our God himself shall fight for you. –

23 And I entreated the Lord at that time, saying:

24 Lord, Lord, you began to show your attendant your strength and your power and the mighty hand and the high arm; for what god is there in heaven or upon the earth who shall do just as you did and according to your strength?

25 Having crossed over, therefore, I shall see this good land that is beyond the Jordan, this good mountain and Antilibanus.

26 And the Lord overlooked me because of you and did not listen to me, and the Lord said to me: Let it be sufficient for you; do not add still more to speak this word.

27 Go up to the summit of the Hewn One, and lifting your eyes, look toward the sea and north and southwest and east, and see with your eyes, because you shall not cross this Jordan.

28 And command Jesus and strengthen him and encourage him, because he shall cross before the face of this people, and he shall cause them to inherit the land that you have seen. –

29 And we sat in a wooded valley very near the house of Phogor.

Chapter 4

1 And now, Israel, hear the ordinances and the judgments, as many as I teach you today to do, so that you may live and be multiplied and, entering, inherit the land that the Lord, the God of your fathers, is giving you.

2 You shall not add to the word that I command you, and you shall not remove from it. Guard the commandments of the Lord your God, as many as I command you today.

3 Your eyes have seen all the things that the Lord our God did to Beelphogor, because every person who went after Beelphogor, the Lord your God wiped him out from among you.

4 But you who are attached to the Lord your God all live on this day.

5 See, I have shown you ordinances and judgments, just as the Lord commanded me, to do thus in the land into which you are entering there to inherit it.

6 And you shall guard and do them, because this is your wisdom and understanding before all the nations, whoever hear all these ordinances and shall say: Behold, a wise and knowledgeable people, this great nation.

7 For what great nation is there that has a god drawing near to them, as the Lord our God is in all things for which we may call upon him?

8 And what great nation is there that has righteous ordinances and judgments according to all this law that I give before you today?

9 Attend to yourself and guard your soul greatly, lest you forget all the words that your eyes have seen; and let them not depart from your heart all the days of your life, and you shall instruct your sons and the sons of your sons

10 the day on which you stood before the Lord your God in Choreb on the day of the assembly, when the Lord said to me: Assemble the people to me, and let them hear my words, so that they may learn to fear me all the days that they live upon the land and may teach their sons.

11 And you approached and stood beneath the mountain, and the mountain was burning with fire as far as heaven: darkness, gloom, storm, a loud voice.

12 And the Lord spoke to you from the midst of the fire; you heard a voice of words and saw no likeness, except a voice.

13 And he reported to you his covenant, which he commanded you to do, the ten words, and he wrote them upon two stone tablets.

14 And the Lord commanded me at that time to teach you ordinances and judgments, for you to do them upon the land into which you are entering there to inherit it.

15 And guard your souls greatly, because you saw no likeness on the day when the Lord spoke to you in Choreb on the mountain from the midst of the fire,

16 lest you act lawlessly and make for yourselves a carved likeness, every image, a likeness of a male or female,

17 a likeness of every animal that is upon the land, a likeness of every winged bird that flies beneath heaven,

18 a likeness of every creeping thing that creeps upon the land, a likeness of every fish, as many as are in the waters beneath the land.

19 And do not, having looked up into heaven and seen the sun and the moon and the stars and all the order of heaven, being led astray, bow to them and serve them, which the Lord your God apportioned, them, to all the nations beneath heaven.

20 But God took you and brought you out from the iron furnace, from Egypt, to be an allotted people for him, as on this day.

21 And the Lord was enraged at me concerning the things said by you and swore that I would not cross this Jordan and would not enter into the land that the Lord God is giving you as an allotment.

22 For I am dying in this land and am not crossing this Jordan, but you are crossing and shall inherit this good land.

23 Pay attention, lest you forget the covenant of the Lord your God that he established with you and make for yourselves a carved likeness of all things that the Lord your God prescribed.

24 Because the Lord your God is a consuming fire, a jealous god.

25 But if you bear sons and sons of your sons and you remain long upon the land and act lawlessly and make a carved likeness of anything and do wicked things before the Lord your God to provoke him,

26 I call both heaven and earth to witness to you today that by destruction you shall be destroyed from the land into which you are crossing the Jordan there to inherit it. You shall not prolong days upon it, but rather by wiping out you shall be wiped out.

27 And the Lord shall scatter you among all the nations, and you shall be left few by number among the nations into which the Lord shall lead you there.

28 And there you shall serve other gods, works of human hands, wood and stones, who shall not see or certainly hear, neither certainly eat nor certainly smell.

29 And there you shall seek the Lord your God and shall find him whenever you search him out from your whole heart and from your whole soul in your affliction.

30 And all these words shall find you at the end of the days, and you shall turn to the Lord your God and listen to his voice,

31 because the Lord your God is a compassionate god; he shall not abandon you or certainly wipe you out, and he shall not forget the covenant of your fathers that he swore to them.

32 Ask about the former days that came before you, from the day on which God created a human upon the land, and from one end of heaven as far as the other end of heaven, whether anything has happened according to this great word, whether anything like it has been heard:

33 whether a nation has heard a voice of a living god speaking from the midst of the fire, in the manner that you have heard, and lived;

34 whether God attempted, entering, to take for himself a nation from the midst of a nation, by trial and by signs and by wonders and by war and by a mighty hand and by a high arm and by great visions, according to all the things that the Lord our God did in Egypt before you while you watched,

35 so that you would know that the Lord your God, he is God, and there is no one else besides him.

36 From heaven his voice became audible to discipline you, and upon the land he showed you his great fire, and you heard his words from the midst of the fire.

37 Because he loved your fathers, and he chose their seed after them, you, and he himself brought you out by his great strength from Egypt,

38 to utterly destroy great nations stronger than you from before your face, to bring you in, to give you their land to inherit, just as you have today.

39 And you shall know today and turn in your mind that the Lord your God, he is God in heaven above and upon the land below, and there is no one else besides him.

40 And you shall guard his ordinances and his commandments, as many as I command you today, so that it may become well for you and for your sons after you, so that you may become long-lived upon the land that the Lord your God is giving you for all the days.

41 Then Moses separated three cities beyond the Jordan from the east of the sun,

42 for the killer to flee there who kills his neighbor without knowing and was not hating him before yesterday and the third day; and he shall flee to one of these cities and live:

43 Bosor in the wilderness in the plain land for Reuben, and Ramoth in Galaad for Gaddi, and Gaulon in Basan for Manasse.

44 This is the law that Moses set before the sons of Israel.

45 These are the testimonies and the ordinances and the judgments, as many as Moses spoke to the sons of Israel in the wilderness when they had gone out from the land of Egypt,

46 beyond the Jordan in a ravine near the house of Phogor, in the land of Seon king of the Amorrites, who dwelt in Esebon, whom Moses and the sons of Israel struck when they had gone out from the land of Egypt.

47 And they inherited his land and the land of Og king of Basan, two kings of the Amorrites who were beyond the Jordan toward the east of the sun,

48 from Aroer, which is on the lip of the winter-stream Arnon, and upon Mount Seon, which is Aermon,

49 all Araba beyond the Jordan toward the east of the sun, under Asedoth the Hewn.

Chapter 5

1 And Moses called all Israel and said to them: Hear, Israel, the ordinances and the judgments, as many as I speak in your ears on this day, and you shall learn them and guard to do them.

2 The Lord your God established a covenant with you in Choreb.

3 The Lord did not establish this covenant with your fathers, but rather with you, you who are all here living today.

4 Face against face the Lord spoke to you on the mountain from the midst of the fire –

5 and I had stood between the Lord and you at that time to report to you the words of the Lord, because you were afraid from before the fire and did not go up into the mountain – saying:

6 I am the Lord your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery.

7 There shall be no other gods for you before my face. –

8 You shall not make for yourself an idol or any likeness of as many things as are in heaven above and as many things as are on the land below and as many things as are in the waters beneath the land.

9 You shall not bow down to them, nor shall you ever serve them, because I am the Lord your God, a jealous god, repaying the sins of fathers upon children as far as the third and fourth generation to those who hate me,

10 and doing mercy to thousands, to those who love me and those who keep my ordinances. –

11 You shall not take the name of the Lord your God in vain, for the Lord will certainly not cleanse the one who takes his name in vain. –

12 Guard the day of the sabbaths, to sanctify it, in the manner that the Lord your God commanded you.

13 Six days you shall labor and do all your works.

14 But on the seventh day are sabbaths to the Lord your God. You shall not do any work on it, you and your sons and your daughter, your servant and your female servant, your ox and your draft animal and all your livestock and the proselyte who sojourns within you, so that your servant and your female servant may rest just as you.

15 And you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt and the Lord your God brought you out from there by a mighty hand and by a high arm. Because of this the Lord your God prescribed to you that you guard the day of the sabbaths and sanctify it. –

16 Honor your father and your mother, in the manner that the Lord your God commanded you, so that it may become well for you and so that you may become long-lived upon the land that the Lord your God gives you. –

17 You shall not commit adultery. –

18 You shall not murder. –

19 You shall not steal. –

20 You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor, false testimony. –

21 You shall not desire the woman of your neighbor. You shall not desire the house of your neighbor, nor his field, nor his servant, nor his female servant, nor his ox, nor his draft animal, nor any of his livestock, nor as many things as belong to your neighbor.

22 These words the Lord spoke to your entire congregation on the mountain from the midst of the fire: darkness, gloom, storm, a loud voice; and he did not add. And he wrote them upon two stone tablets and gave them to me.

23 And it happened when you heard the voice from the midst of the fire and the mountain was burning with fire, that you approached me, all the leaders of your tribes and your council of elders,

24 and you were saying: Behold, the Lord our God showed us his glory, and we heard his voice from the midst of the fire. On this day we saw that God shall speak to a person and he shall live.

25 And now, let us not die, because this great fire shall utterly consume us. If we ourselves continue to hear the voice of the Lord our God any longer, then we shall die.

26 For what flesh is there that has heard a voice of a living god speaking from the midst of the fire as we have and shall live?

27 You approach and hear as many things as the Lord our God may say, and you shall speak to us all the things that the Lord our God may speak to you, and we shall hear and do them.

28 And the Lord heard the voice of your words as you were speaking to me, and the Lord said to me: I heard the voice of the words of this people, as many things as they spoke to you; all the things that they spoke were correct.

29 Who shall give their heart to be thus in them, so as to fear me and guard my commandments all the days, so that it may be well for them and for their sons through the age?

30 Walk, say to them: Turn back, you, to your houses.

31 But you, stand here with me, and I shall speak to you the commandments and the ordinances and the judgments, as many as you shall teach them, and let them do them in the land that I am giving them as an allotment.

32 And you shall guard to do in the manner that the Lord your God commanded you; you shall not turn aside to the right or to the left,

33 according to all the road that the Lord your God commanded you to walk upon, so that he may give you rest and it may be well for you and you may become long-lived upon the land that you shall inherit.

Chapter 6

1 And these are the commandments and the ordinances and the judgments, as many as the Lord our God commanded to teach you to do thus in the land into which you are entering there to inherit it,

2 so that you may fear the Lord your God by guarding all his ordinances and his commandments, as many as I command you today, you and your sons and the sons of your sons, all the days of your life, so that you may become long-lived.

3 And hear, Israel, and guard to do them, so that it may be well for you and so that you may be multiplied greatly, just as the Lord, the God of your fathers, spoke, to give you a land flowing with milk and honey.

4 And these are the ordinances and the judgments, as many as the Lord commanded the sons of Israel in the wilderness when they had gone out from the land of Egypt: Hear, Israel; the Lord our God is one Lord.

5 And you shall love the Lord your God from your whole heart and from your whole soul and from your whole power.

6 And these words, as many as I command you today, shall be in your heart and in your soul.

7 And you shall teach them to your sons and speak about them while sitting in your house and traveling on the road and lying down and rising up.

8 And you shall fasten them as a sign upon your hand, and it shall be immovable before your eyes.

9 And you shall write them upon the doorposts of your houses and of your gates.

10 And it shall be when the Lord your God brings you into the land that he swore to your fathers, Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, to give you, great and beautiful cities that you did not build,

11 houses full of all good things that you did not fill, hewn pits that you did not hew out, vineyards and olive groves that you did not plant, and when you have eaten and been filled,

12 pay attention to yourself, lest you forget the Lord your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery.

13 You shall fear the Lord your God, and you shall serve him and be joined to him and swear by his name.

14 You shall not go after other gods, from the gods of the nations around you,

15 because the Lord your God among you is a jealous god, lest the Lord your God, becoming angry, be enraged at you and utterly destroy you from the face of the land.

16 You shall not put the Lord your God to the test, in the manner that you put him to the test at Temptation.

17 By guarding, you shall guard the commandments of the Lord your God, the testimonies and the ordinances, as many as he commanded you.

18 And you shall do what is pleasing and good before the Lord your God, so that it may become well for you and you may enter and inherit the good land that the Lord swore to your fathers,

19 to drive out all your enemies from before your face, just as he spoke.

20 And it shall be when your son asks you tomorrow, saying: What are the testimonies and the ordinances and the judgments, as many as the Lord our God commanded us?

21 And you shall say to your son: We were household servants to Pharao in the land of Egypt, and the Lord brought us out from there by a mighty hand and by a high arm.

22 And the Lord gave signs and wonders, great and evil, in Egypt, in Pharao and in his house, before us.

23 And he brought us out from there so that he might bring us in, to give us this land that he swore to give to our fathers.

24 And the Lord commanded us to do all these ordinances, to fear the Lord our God, so that it may be well for us all the days, so that we may live just as also today.

25 And mercy shall be for us if we guard to do all these commandments before the Lord our God, just as the Lord commanded us.

Chapter 7

1 But if the Lord your God brings you into the land into which you are entering there to inherit it, and removes great nations from before your face, the Chettite and Gergesite and Amorrite and Chanaanite and Pherezite and Evite and Jebousite, seven nations, numerous and stronger than you,

2 and the Lord your God shall deliver them into your hands and you shall strike them, with obliteration you shall obliterate them. You shall not establish a covenant with them, nor shall you ever show them mercy.

3 Nor shall you ever intermarry with them. You shall not give your daughter to his son, and you shall not take his daughter for your son.

4 For he shall turn your son away from me, and he shall serve other gods, and the Lord shall be angered with wrath against you and shall utterly destroy you quickly.

5 But thus you shall do to them: You shall take down their altars and crush their pillars and cut down their groves and burn the carved images of their gods with fire.

6 Because you are a holy people to the Lord your God, and the Lord your God preferred you to be a peculiar people for him beyond all the nations that are upon the face of the land.

7 It was not because you are more numerous than all the nations that the Lord preferred you and chose you – for you are the fewest of all the nations –

8 but because the Lord loves you and keeps the oath that he swore to your fathers, the Lord brought you out by a mighty hand and by a high arm and redeemed you out of a house of slavery, from the hand of Pharao king of Egypt.

9 And you shall know that the Lord your God, he is God, a faithful god, who guards covenant and mercy for those who love him and those who guard his commandments, for a thousand generations,

10 and repays those who hate him to their face, to utterly destroy them. And he shall not delay toward those who hate him; to their face he shall repay them.

11 And you shall guard these commandments and ordinances and judgments, as many as I command you today to do.

12 And it shall be whenever you hear all these ordinances and guard and do them, that the Lord your God shall also safeguard for you the covenant and the mercy that he swore to your fathers.

13 And he shall love you and bless you and multiply you, and he shall bless the offspring of your womb and the fruit of your land, your wheat and your wine and your oil, the herds of your cattle and the flocks of your sheep, upon the land that the Lord swore to your fathers to give you.

14 You shall be blessed beyond all the nations. There shall be no childless man or barren woman among you, or among your livestock.

15 And the Lord shall remove from you every infirmity, and all the evil diseases of Egypt that you have seen and as many as you knew, he shall not place upon you, but he shall place them upon all those who hate you.

16 And you shall eat all the spoils of the nations that the Lord your God is giving you. Your eye shall not spare them, and you shall not serve their gods, because this is a stumbling block for you.

17 But if you say in your mind: This nation is more numerous than I am; how shall I be able utterly to destroy them?

18 You shall not fear them. By remembrance you shall remember the things that the Lord your God did to Pharao and to all the Egyptians,

19 the great trials that your eyes saw, those great signs and wonders, the mighty hand and the high arm, how the Lord your God brought you out. Thus the Lord our God shall do to all the nations whose face you fear.

20 And the Lord your God shall send the hornets against them until those left behind and those hidden from you are wiped out.

21 You shall not be wounded from before their face, because the Lord your God is among you, a great and mighty god.

22 And the Lord your God shall consume these nations from before your face little by little. You shall not be able utterly to consume them quickly, lest the land become desolate and the wild beasts multiply against you.

23 And the Lord your God shall deliver them into your hands and shall destroy them with great destruction until he utterly destroys them.

24 And he shall deliver their kings into your hands, and their name shall perish from that place. No one shall stand against your face until you utterly destroy them.

25 You shall burn the carved images of their gods with fire. You shall not desire silver or gold from them and shall not take it for yourself, lest you stumble because of it, because it is an abomination to the Lord your God.

26 And you shall not bring an abomination into your house, and you shall be an anathema like it. With loathing you shall loathe it, and with abomination you shall abhor it, because it is an anathema.

Chapter 8

1 All the commandments that I command you today you shall guard to do, so that you may live and be multiplied and enter and inherit the land that the Lord your God swore to your fathers.

2 And you shall remember all the road by which the Lord your God led you in the wilderness, so that he might afflict you and put you to the test and the things in your heart might be discerned, whether you would guard his commandments or not.

3 And he afflicted you and made you hungry and fed you the manna, which your fathers did not know, so that he might declare to you that a person shall not live on bread alone, but a person shall live on every word that proceeds through the mouth of God.

4 Your garments were not worn down from you; your feet did not become callused. Behold, forty years.

5 And you shall know in your heart that as if a person might discipline his son, thus the Lord your God shall discipline you.

6 And you shall guard the commandments of the Lord your God, to walk in his ways and to fear him.

7 For the Lord your God is bringing you into a good and extensive land, where there are winter-streams of water and springs of depths coming out through the plains and through the mountains,

8 a land of wheat and barley, vines, fig trees, pomegranates, a land of olive oil and honey,

9 a land upon which you shall eat your bread not with poverty and shall lack nothing upon it, a land whose stones are iron and from whose mountains you shall mine copper.

10 And you shall eat and be filled and bless the Lord your God upon the good land that he gave you.

11 Pay attention to yourself, lest you forget the Lord your God by not guarding his commandments and his judgments and ordinances, as many as I command you today,

12 lest, after eating and being filled and building beautiful houses and dwelling in them,

13 and when your cattle and your sheep have been multiplied for you, silver and gold have been multiplied for you, and everything that you shall have has been multiplied for you,

14 you be exalted in heart and forget the Lord your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery,

15 who led you through that great and fearful wilderness, where there were a biting snake and a scorpion and thirst, where there was no water, who brought out for you from a sheer rock a spring of water,

16 who fed you the manna in the wilderness, which your fathers did not know, so that he might afflict you and put you to the test and do you good at the end of your days.

17 Do not say in your heart: My strength and the might of my hand made this great power for me.

18 And you shall remember the Lord your God, because he gives you strength to make power and so that he may establish his covenant that the Lord swore to your fathers, as today.

19 And it shall be if by forgetting you forget the Lord your God and go after other gods and serve them and bow to them, I call both heaven and earth to witness to you today that by destruction you shall be destroyed.

20 Just as also the remaining nations that the Lord destroys from before your face, thus you shall be destroyed, because you did not listen to the voice of the Lord your God.

Chapter 9

1 Hear, Israel: You are crossing the Jordan today to enter and inherit nations great and stronger than you, great cities walled as far as heaven,

2 a great and numerous and tall people, sons of Enak, whom you know and of whom you have heard: Who shall stand against the face of the sons of Enak?

3 And you shall know today that the Lord your God, he goes before your face. He is a consuming fire. He shall utterly destroy them, and he shall turn them away from before your face, and you shall destroy them, just as the Lord said to you.

4 Do not say in your heart when the Lord your God utterly consumes these nations from before your face, saying: Because of my righteousnesses the Lord brought me in to inherit this good land. But because of the impiety of these nations the Lord shall utterly destroy them from before your face.

5 It is not because of your righteousness or because of the piety of your heart that you are entering to inherit their land, but because of the impiety of these nations the Lord shall utterly destroy them from before your face, and so that he may establish his covenant that he swore to your fathers, Abraham and Isaac and Jacob.

6 And you shall know today that it is not because of your righteousnesses that the Lord your God is giving you this good land to inherit, because you are a stiff-necked people.

7 Remember; do not forget how much you provoked the Lord your God in the wilderness. From the day that you went out from Egypt until you came to this place, you continued being disobedient in the things toward the Lord.

8 And in Choreb you provoked the Lord, and the Lord was enraged against you, to utterly destroy you,

9 when I went up into the mountain to receive the stone tablets, tablets of the covenant that the Lord established with you. And I remained on the mountain forty days and forty nights; I did not eat bread and did not drink water.

10 And the Lord gave me the two stone tablets written by the finger of God, and on them had been written all the words that the Lord spoke to you on the mountain on the day of the assembly.

11 And it happened after forty days and forty nights that the Lord gave me the two stone tablets, tablets of the covenant.

12 And the Lord said to me: Rise, go down quickly from here, because your people whom you brought out from the land of Egypt acted lawlessly. They quickly transgressed from the road that you commanded them; they made for themselves a cast thing.

13 And the Lord said to me: I have spoken to you once and twice, saying: I have seen this people, and behold, they are a stiff-necked people.

14 Leave me to utterly destroy them, and I shall wipe away their name from beneath heaven and make you into a nation great and strong and much more numerous than this one.

15 And turning, I went down from the mountain, and the mountain was burning with fire, and the two tablets were upon my two hands.

16 And when I saw that you had sinned before the Lord your God and made for yourselves a cast thing and transgressed from the road that the Lord commanded you,

17 then, taking hold of the two tablets, I threw them from my two hands and crushed them before you.

18 And I entreated before the Lord a second time, just as also the first, for forty days and forty nights – I did not eat bread and did not drink water – concerning all your sins by which you sinned, doing what was wicked before the Lord your God, to provoke him.

19 And I am terrified because of the anger and the wrath, because the Lord was provoked against you, to utterly destroy you. And the Lord listened to me also at this time.

20 And the Lord was greatly enraged against Aaron, to utterly destroy him, and I prayed also concerning Aaron at that time.

21 And your sin that you made, the calf, I took and burned it with fire and broke it in pieces, grinding it thoroughly until it became fine. And it became like dust, and I threw the dust into the winter-stream that descends from the mountain. –

22 And at Burning and at Temptation and at the Memorials of Desire you were provoking the Lord your God.

23 And when the Lord sent you out from Cades Barne, saying: Go up and inherit the land that I am giving you, you disobeyed the word of the Lord your God and did not trust him and did not listen to his voice.

24 You were disobedient in the things toward the Lord from the day when he became known to you. –

25 And I entreated before the Lord for forty days and forty nights, as many as I entreated – for the Lord said to utterly destroy you –

26 and I prayed to God and said: Lord, Lord, King of the gods, do not utterly destroy your people and your portion, whom you redeemed by your great strength, whom you brought out from the land of Egypt by your great strength and by your mighty hand and by your high arm.

27 Remember Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, your attendants, to whom you swore by yourself. Do not look upon the hardness of this people and their impieties and their sins,

28 lest those dwelling in the land from which you brought us say: Because the Lord was not able to bring them into the land that he told them of, and because he hated them, he brought them out to kill them in the wilderness.

29 And these are your people and your allotment, whom you brought out from the land of Egypt by your great strength and by your high arm.

Chapter 10

1 At that time the Lord said to me: Hew for yourself two stone tablets like the first ones and come up to me onto the mountain. And you shall make for yourself a wooden ark.

2 And I shall write upon the tablets the words that were in the first tablets, which you crushed, and you shall put them into the ark.

3 And I made an ark from incorruptible wood and hewed the two stone tablets like the first ones. And I went up into the mountain, and the two tablets were upon my hands.

4 And he wrote upon the tablets, according to the first writing, the ten words that the Lord spoke to you on the mountain from the midst of the fire, and the Lord gave them to me.

5 And turning, I went down from the mountain and put the tablets into the ark that I made, and they were there, just as the Lord commanded me. –

6 And the sons of Israel departed from Beroth of the sons of Jakim Misadai. There Aaron died and was buried there, and Eleazar his son served as priest in his place.

7 From there they departed to Gadgad, and from Gadgad to Etebatha, a land of winter-streams of water.

8 At that time the Lord distinguished the tribe of Levi to carry the ark of the covenant of the Lord, to stand before the Lord, to minister, and to invoke his name until this day.

9 Because of this there is no portion and allotment for the Levites among their brothers. The Lord himself is his allotment, just as he said to him.

10 And I had stood on the mountain forty days and forty nights, and the Lord listened to me also at this time, and the Lord was not willing utterly to destroy you.

11 And the Lord said to me: Walk, set out before this people, and let them enter and inherit the land that I swore to their fathers to give them.

12 And now, Israel, what does the Lord your God request from you except to fear the Lord your God, to walk in all his ways and to love him and to serve the Lord your God from your whole heart and from your whole soul,

13 to guard the commandments of the Lord your God and his ordinances, as many as I command you today, so that it may be well for you?

14 Behold, the heaven and the heaven of heaven, the land and all that is in it, belong to the Lord your God.

15 Nevertheless, the Lord preferred your fathers, to love them, and chose their seed after them, you, beyond all the nations, as on this day.

16 And you shall circumcise your hard-heartedness, and you shall no longer harden your neck.

17 For the Lord your God, he is God of the gods and Lord of the lords, the great and strong and fearsome God, who does not marvel at a face, nor shall he certainly take a gift,

18 who does judgment for the proselyte and orphan and widow, and loves the proselyte, to give him bread and a garment.

19 And you shall love the proselyte, for you were proselytes in the land of Egypt.

20 You shall fear the Lord your God, and you shall serve him and be joined to him and swear by his name.

21 He is your boast and he is your God, who did among you these great and glorious things that your eyes saw.

22 With seventy souls your fathers went down into Egypt, but now the Lord your God made you like the stars of heaven in multitude.

Chapter 11

1 And you shall love the Lord your God and guard his observances and his ordinances and his judgments all the days.

2 And you shall know today that it was not your children, as many as do not know and did not see the discipline of the Lord your God and his great deeds and the mighty hand and the high arm,

3 and his signs and his wonders, as many as he did in the midst of Egypt to Pharao king of Egypt and to all his land,

4 and as many things as he did to the force of the Egyptians, their chariots and their horse force, how the water of the Red Sea flooded over their face as they pursued from behind you, and the Lord destroyed them until this day,

5 and as many things as he did to you in the wilderness until you came to this place,

6 and as many things as he did to Dathan and Abiron, sons of Eliab son of Reuben, whom the land, opening its mouth, swallowed, and their houses and their tents and all their substance that was with them, in the midst of all Israel,

7 because your eyes have seen all the great works of the Lord, as many as he did to you today.

8 And you shall guard all his commandments, as many as I command you today, so that you may live and be multiplied and, entering, inherit the land into which you are crossing the Jordan there to inherit it,

9 so that you may become long-lived upon the land that the Lord swore to your fathers to give to them and to their seed after them, a land flowing with milk and honey.

10 For the land into which you are entering there to inherit it is not like the land of Egypt from which you went out, where they sow the seed and water it with their feet like a vegetable garden.

11 But the land into which you are entering there to inherit it is a mountainous and plain land; it drinks water from the rain of heaven,

12 a land that the Lord your God oversees. Continually the eyes of the Lord your God are upon it, from the beginning of the year even until the completion of the year.

13 But if by hearing you listen to all his commandments, as many as I command you today, to love the Lord your God and to serve him from your whole heart and from your whole soul,

14 then he shall give the rain to your land in season, early and late, and you shall bring in your wheat and your wine and your oil.

15 And he shall give fodder in your fields for your livestock, and when you have eaten and been filled,

16 pay attention to yourself, lest your heart be broadened and you transgress and serve other gods and bow to them,

17 and the Lord, enraged with anger against you, close up heaven, and there shall be no rain, and the land shall not give its fruit, and you shall perish quickly from the good land that the Lord gave you.

18 And you shall put these words into your heart and into your soul, and you shall fasten them as a sign upon your hand, and it shall be immovable before your eyes.

19 And you shall teach your children to speak them while sitting in the house and traveling on the road and lying down and rising up.

20 And you shall write them upon the doorposts of your houses and of your gates,

21 so that you may live many days, and the days of your sons upon the land that the Lord swore to your fathers to give them may be many, like the days of heaven upon the land.

22 And it shall be if by hearing you hear all these commandments, as many as I command you today to do, to love the Lord our God and to walk in all his ways and to be joined to him,

23 that the Lord shall drive out all these nations from before your face, and you shall inherit nations great and stronger than you.

24 Every place where the track of your foot may tread shall be yours. From the wilderness and Antilibanus and from the great river, the river Euphrates, and as far as the sea toward the west shall be your borders.

25 No one shall stand against your face. The Lord your God shall place your trembling and your fear upon the face of all the land on which you may set foot, in the manner that the Lord spoke to you.

26 Behold, I give before you today a blessing and a curse:

27 the blessing, if you hear the commandments of the Lord your God that I command you today,

28 and the curses, if you do not hear the commandments of the Lord your God, as many as I command you today, and you are led astray from the road that I commanded you, going to serve other gods that you do not know.

29 And it shall be when the Lord your God brings you into the land into which you are crossing there to inherit it, that you shall give the blessing upon Mount Garizin and the curse upon Mount Gaibal.

30 [Behold, are these not beyond the Jordan, behind the road of the setting of the sun, in the land of Chanaan, the one dwelling toward the west, adjoining Golgol, near the high oak?]

31 For you are crossing the Jordan, entering to inherit the land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment all the days, and you shall inherit it and dwell in it.

32 And you shall guard yourselves to do all his commands and these judgments, as many as I give before you today.

Chapter 12

1 And these are the commands and the judgments that you shall guard to do upon the land that the Lord, the God of your fathers, is giving you as an allotment, all the days that you live upon the land.

2 By destruction you shall destroy all the places in which those whom you are inheriting served their gods there, upon the high mountains and upon the dunes and beneath a dense tree.

3 And you shall dig down their altars and crush their pillars and cut down their groves and burn the carved images of their gods with fire, and their name shall perish from that place.

4 You shall not do thus to the Lord your God,

5 but rather to the place that the Lord your God may choose in one of your tribes, to name his name there, for it to be called upon; and you shall seek out and enter there.

6 And you shall bring there your whole burnt offerings and your sacrifices and your firstfruits and your vows and your voluntary offerings and the firstborn of your cattle and of your sheep.

7 And you shall eat there before the Lord your God and rejoice over everything upon which you may lay your hand, you and your houses, because the Lord your God blessed you.

8 You shall not do all the things that we do here today, each doing what is pleasing before him,

9 for you have not come until now into the rest and into the inheritance that the Lord your God is giving you.

10 And you shall cross the Jordan and dwell upon the land that the Lord your God is causing you to inherit, and he shall give you rest from all your enemies around you, and you shall dwell with security.

11 And the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there shall be the place to which you shall bring all the things that I command you today: your whole burnt offerings and your sacrifices and your tithes and the firstfruits of your hands and your gifts and every choice thing among your gifts, as many as you may vow to your God.

12 And you shall rejoice before the Lord your God, you and your sons and your daughters, your servants and your female servants and the Levite who is at your gates, because there is no portion or allotment for him with you.

13 Pay attention to yourself, lest you offer up your whole burnt offerings in every place that you may see,

14 but rather in the place that the Lord your God may choose in one of your tribes. There you shall bring up your whole burnt offerings, and there you shall do all the things that I command you today.

15 But according to every desire of yours you shall slaughter and eat meat according to the blessing of the Lord your God that he gave you in every city. The unclean among you and the clean shall eat it together, like a gazelle or a deer.

16 Except you shall not eat the blood; you shall pour it out upon the land like water.

17 You shall not be able to eat in your cities the tithe of your wheat and your wine and your oil, the firstborn of your cattle and your sheep, and all the vows, as many as you may vow, and your acknowledgments and the firstfruits of your hands,

18 but rather you shall eat them before the Lord your God in the place that the Lord your God may choose for himself, you and your son and your daughter, your servant and your female servant and the proselyte who is in your cities, and you shall rejoice before the Lord your God over everything upon which you may lay your hand.

19 Pay attention to yourself, lest you abandon the Levite for all the time that you may live upon the land.

20 But if the Lord your God widens your borders, just as he spoke to you, and you say: I shall eat meat, if your soul desires so as to eat meat, then according to every desire of your soul you shall eat meat.

21 But if the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there is farther away from you, then you shall slaughter from your cattle and from your sheep that God may give you, in the manner that I commanded you, and you shall eat in your cities according to the desire of your soul.

22 As the gazelle and the deer are eaten, thus you shall eat it; the unclean among you and the clean shall eat it alike.

23 Pay close attention not to eat blood, because its blood is soul. The soul shall not be eaten with the meat.

24 You shall not eat it; you shall pour it out upon the land like water.

25 You shall not eat it, so that it may become well for you and for your sons after you, if you do what is good and pleasing before the Lord your God.

26 Except your holy things, if they come to be for you, and your vows, taking them, you shall come to the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there.

27 And you shall make your whole burnt offerings. You shall bring the meat up upon the altar of the Lord your God, but you shall pour the blood of your sacrifices toward the base of the altar of the Lord your God, and you shall eat the meat.

28 Guard and hear and you shall do all the words that I command you, so that it may become well for you and for your sons through the age, if you do what is good and pleasing before the Lord your God.

29 But if the Lord your God utterly destroys from before your face the nations into which you are entering there to inherit their land, and you inherit them and dwell in their land,

30 pay attention to yourself, lest you seek out to follow them after they have been utterly destroyed from before your face. You shall certainly not seek out their gods, saying: How do these nations act toward their gods? I also shall do so.

31 You shall not do thus to the Lord your God, for they did for their gods the abominations that the Lord hated, because they burn their sons and their daughters with fire for their gods.

Chapter 13

1 Every word that I command you today, this you shall guard to do. You shall not add to it or remove from it.

2 But if a prophet or one dreaming a dream rises among you and gives you a sign or a wonder,

3 and the sign or the wonder of which he spoke to you comes, saying: Let us go and serve other gods that you do not know,

4 you shall not listen to the words of that prophet or of that one dreaming that dream, because the Lord your God is testing you, to know whether you love the Lord your God from your whole heart and from your whole soul.

5 After the Lord your God you shall go, and you shall fear him and guard his commandments and listen to his voice and be added to him.

6 And that prophet or that one dreaming the dream shall die, for he spoke to lead you astray from the Lord your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, who redeemed you from slavery, to thrust you out from the road upon which the Lord your God commanded you to walk. And you shall make the evil one disappear from among you yourselves.

7 But if your brother from your father or from your mother, or your son or your daughter or the woman who is in your bosom or the friend equal to your soul secretly urges you, saying: Let us walk and serve other gods that you and your fathers did not know,

8 from the gods of the nations around you, those near you or those far from you, from one end of the land as far as the other end of the land,

9 you shall not consent with him and shall not listen to him, and your eye shall not spare him; you shall not yearn for him, nor shall you ever shelter him.

10 By reporting, you shall report concerning him. Your hands shall be upon him first to kill him, and the hands of all the people last.

11 And they shall stone him with stones, and he shall die, because he sought to turn you away from the Lord your God, who brought you out from the land of Egypt, out of a house of slavery.

12 And all Israel, hearing, shall fear, and they shall not add still more to do according to this wicked matter among you.

13 But if you hear, in one of your cities that the Lord your God is giving you to dwell there, people saying:

14 Lawless men came out from among you and turned away all those dwelling in their city, saying: Let us go and serve other gods that you did not know,

15 then you shall inquire and investigate thoroughly, and behold, the word is clearly true: this abomination has happened among you,

16 by killing you shall kill all those dwelling in that city with slaughter by the sword. With an anathema you shall anathematize it and everything in it.

17 And you shall gather all its spoils into its thoroughfares and burn the city with fire and all its spoils all together before the Lord your God, and it shall be uninhabited through the age; it shall not be rebuilt any longer.

18 Nothing from the anathema shall be joined to your hand, so that the Lord may turn from the rage of his anger and give you mercy and show you mercy and multiply you, in the manner that the Lord swore to your fathers,

19 if you listen to the voice of the Lord your God, to guard all his commandments, as many as I command you today, to do what is good and pleasing before the Lord your God.

Chapter 14

1 You are sons of the Lord your God. You shall not gash yourselves, and you shall not place a bald patch between your eyes over a dead person.

2 Because you are a holy people to the Lord your God, and the Lord your God chose you to become a peculiar people for him from all the nations upon the face of the land.

3 You shall not eat any abomination.

4 These are the animals that you shall eat: a calf from cattle and a lamb from sheep and a young goat from goats,

5 a deer and a gazelle and a buffalo and a goat-deer and a white-rump, an oryx and a camelopard.

6 Every animal that divides the hoof and splits the claws into two divisions of the hoof and brings up cud among the animals, these you shall eat.

7 And these you shall not eat from those that bring up cud and from those that divide the hooves and split the claws: the camel and the hare and the hyrax, because they bring up cud but do not divide the hoof; these are unclean for you.

8 And the pig, because it divides the hoof and splits the claws of the hoof but does not chew cud, this is unclean for you. You shall not eat from their flesh and shall not touch their carcasses. –

9 And these you shall eat from all the things in the waters: all the things in them that have fins and scales you shall eat.

10 And all the things that do not have fins and scales you shall not eat; they are unclean for you. –

11 Every clean bird you shall eat.

12 And these you shall not eat from among them: the eagle and the griffon-vulture and the sea eagle,

13 and the vulture and the kite and those like it,

14 and every raven and those like it,

15 and the ostrich and the owl and the gull,

16 and the heron and the swan and the ibis,

17 and the cormorant and the hawk and those like it and the hoopoe and the night raven,

18 and the pelican and the plover and those like it and the purple swamphen and the bat.

19 All the creeping things among the flying creatures are unclean for you; you shall not eat from them.

20 Every clean flying creature you shall eat. –

21 You shall not eat anything dead of itself. It shall be given to the sojourner who is in your cities, and he shall eat it, or you shall give it over to the foreigner, because you are a holy people to the Lord your God. – You shall not boil a lamb in its mother’s milk.

22 You shall tithe a tenth of every yield of your seed, the yield of your field, year by year,

23 and you shall eat it before the Lord your God in the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there. You shall bring the tithes of your wheat and your wine and your oil, the firstborn of your cattle and your sheep, so that you may learn to fear the Lord your God all the days.

24 But if the road becomes far from you and you are not able to bring them up, because the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there is far from you, because the Lord your God shall bless you,

25 then you shall exchange them for silver and take the silver in your hands and travel to the place that the Lord your God may choose.

26 And you shall give the silver for anything that your soul may desire, for cattle or for sheep, for wine or for sikera or for anything that your soul may desire, and you shall eat there before the Lord your God and rejoice, you and your house,

27 and the Levite who is in your cities, because there is no portion or allotment for him with you. –

28 After three years you shall bring out all the tithe of your yields; in that year you shall place it in your cities,

29 and the Levite shall come, because there is no portion or allotment for him with you, and the proselyte and the orphan and the widow who is in your cities, and they shall eat and be filled, so that the Lord your God may bless you in all the works that you may do.

Chapter 15

1 After seven years you shall make a release.

2 And thus is the command of the release: You shall release every private debt that your neighbor owes you, and you shall not exact it from your brother, because a release has been proclaimed to the Lord your God.

3 From the foreigner you shall exact whatever of yours may be with him, but for your brother you shall make a release of your debt.

4 Because there shall be no needy person among you, because by blessing the Lord your God shall bless you in the land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment to inherit it,

5 if by hearing you listen to the voice of the Lord your God, to guard and do all these commandments, as many as I command you today.

6 Because the Lord your God blessed you in the manner that he spoke to you, and you shall lend to many nations, but you shall not borrow, and you shall rule many nations, but they shall not rule you.

7 But if there comes to be among you a needy person from among your brothers, in one of your cities in the land that the Lord your God is giving you, you shall not withhold your heart, nor shall you ever tightly close your hand from your brother who is in need.

8 By opening, you shall open your hands to him; with a loan you shall lend him as much as he needs, according to as much as he lacks.

9 Pay attention to yourself, lest there be a secret matter in your heart, a lawless thing, saying: The seventh year, the year of release, is drawing near, and your eye becomes wicked toward your brother who is in need, and you shall not give to him, and he shall cry against you to the Lord, and there shall be great sin among you.

10 By giving, you shall give to him, and with a loan you shall lend him as much as he needs, and you shall not be grieved in your heart while you give to him, because on account of this matter the Lord your God shall bless you in all your works and in everything upon which you may lay your hand.

11 For a needy person shall certainly not cease from the land. Because of this I command you to do this matter, saying: By opening, you shall open your hands to your poor brother and to the one in need who is upon your land.

12 But if your brother, a Hebrew man or a Hebrew woman, is sold to you, he shall serve you six years, and in the seventh you shall send him out free from you.

13 But when you send him out free from you, you shall not send him out empty.

14 With provisions you shall provision him from your sheep and from your grain and from your winepress. Just as the Lord your God blessed you, you shall give to him.

15 And you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt and the Lord your God redeemed you from there. Because of this I command you to do this matter.

16 But if he says to you: I shall not go out from you, because he has loved you and your house, because it is well for him beside you,

17 then you shall take the awl and pierce his ear against the door, and he shall be a household servant for you through the age. And you shall do likewise to your female servant.

18 It shall not be hard before you when they are sent out free from you, because for the annual wage of a hired worker he served you six years. And the Lord your God shall bless you in all the things that you may do.

19 Every firstborn that may be born among your cattle and among your sheep, the males, you shall sanctify to the Lord your God. You shall not work with your firstborn calf, and you shall certainly not shear the firstborn of your sheep.

20 Before the Lord you shall eat it year from year in the place that the Lord your God may choose, you and your house.

21 But if there is a blemish in it, lame or blind or indeed any evil blemish, you shall not sacrifice it to the Lord your God.

22 In your cities you shall eat it; the unclean among you and the clean shall eat it alike, like a gazelle or a deer.

23 Except you shall not eat the blood; you shall pour it out upon the land like water.

Chapter 16

1 Guard the month of the new things, and you shall make the pascha for the Lord your God, because in the month of the new things you went out from Egypt by night.

2 And you shall sacrifice the pascha to the Lord your God, sheep and cattle, in the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there.

3 You shall not eat leaven with it. Seven days you shall eat unleavened things with it, bread of affliction, because you went out from Egypt in haste, so that you may remember the day of your departure from the land of Egypt all the days of your life.

4 Leaven shall not be seen among you in all your borders for seven days, and none of the meat that you may sacrifice in the evening on the first day shall lie overnight until morning.

5 You shall not be able to sacrifice the pascha in any of your cities that the Lord your God is giving you,

6 but rather in the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there you shall sacrifice the pascha in the evening toward the setting of the sun, at the time when you went out from Egypt,

7 and you shall boil and roast and eat it in the place that the Lord your God may choose, and you shall turn back in the morning and go to your houses.

8 Six days you shall eat unleavened things, and on the seventh day a departure, a feast to the Lord your God. You shall do no work in it except as much as shall be done for a soul. –

9 Seven complete weeks you shall count out for yourself. When you begin the sickle upon the harvest, you shall begin to count out seven weeks.

10 And you shall make a feast of weeks for the Lord your God according as your hand has strength, as much as he may give you, according as the Lord your God has blessed you.

11 And you shall rejoice before the Lord your God, you and your son and your daughter, your servant and your female servant and the Levite in your cities and the proselyte and the orphan and the widow among you, in the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there,

12 and you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt, and you shall guard and do these commandments. –

13 You shall make a feast of tents for yourself for seven days when you gather in from your threshing floor and from your winepress,

14 and you shall rejoice in your feast, you and your son and your daughter, your servant and your female servant and the Levite and the proselyte and the orphan and the widow who is in your cities.

15 Seven days you shall celebrate a feast for the Lord your God in the place that the Lord your God may choose for himself. And if the Lord your God blesses you in all your yields and in every work of your hands, you shall be rejoicing. –

16 Three times in the year every male of yours shall appear before the Lord your God in the place that the Lord may choose, at the feast of unleavened things and at the feast of weeks and at the feast of tent-pitching. You shall not appear before the Lord your God empty.

17 Each according to the strength of your hands, according to the blessing of the Lord your God that he gave you.

18 Judges and scribal officers you shall appoint for yourself in all your cities that the Lord your God is giving you, by tribes, and they shall judge the people with just judgment.

19 They shall not turn aside judgment; they shall not recognize a face or take a gift, for gifts blind the eyes of the wise and remove the words of the righteous.

20 Justly you shall pursue what is just, so that you may live and, entering, inherit the land that the Lord your God is giving you.

21 You shall not plant for yourself a grove, any tree, beside the altar of the Lord your God that you make for yourself.

22 You shall not set up for yourself a pillar, which the Lord your God hated.

Chapter 17

1 You shall not sacrifice to the Lord your God a calf or a sheep in which there is a blemish, any evil thing, because it is an abomination to the Lord your God.

2 But if there is found among you, in one of your cities that the Lord your God is giving you, a man or a woman who does what is evil before the Lord your God, to transgress his covenant,

3 and, going, they serve other gods and bow to them, to the sun or the moon or any of the things of the order of heaven, which he did not command,

4 and it is reported to you, you shall seek out thoroughly, and behold, the matter has truly happened, this abomination has happened in Israel,

5 then you shall bring out that man or that woman, and you shall stone them with stones, and they shall die.

6 Upon two witnesses or upon three witnesses the one who is to die shall die; he shall not die upon one witness.

7 And the hand of the witnesses shall be upon him first to put him to death, and the hand of all the people last; and you shall remove the evil one from among you yourselves.

8 But if a matter in judgment is beyond your ability, between blood and blood and between judgment and judgment and between touch and touch and between dispute and dispute, matters of judgment in your cities, then, rising, you shall go up to the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there,

9 and you shall come to the priests, the Levites, and to the judge who may be in those days, and after seeking out they shall report the judgment to you.

10 And you shall do according to the matter that they may report to you from the place that the Lord your God may choose for his name to be called there, and you shall carefully guard to do according to everything that may be laid down as law for you.

11 According to the law and according to the judgment that they may tell you, you shall do; you shall not turn aside from the word that they may report to you, right or left.

12 And the man who may act in arrogance so as not to obey the priest who stands to minister in the name of the Lord your God or the judge who may be in those days, that man shall die, and you shall remove the evil one from Israel.

13 And all the people, hearing, shall fear and shall not act impiously any longer.

14 But if you enter the land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment and inherit it and dwell upon it and say: I shall appoint a ruler over myself just as the other nations around me,

15 by appointing you shall appoint over yourself a ruler whom the Lord your God may choose. From your brothers you shall appoint a ruler over yourself; you shall not be able to appoint over yourself a foreign man, because he is not your brother.

16 Because he shall not multiply horses for himself, nor shall he ever turn the people back to Egypt so that he may multiply horses for himself, for the Lord said: You shall not add to return by this road any longer.

17 And he shall not multiply wives for himself, nor shall his heart turn away; and silver and gold he shall not multiply for himself exceedingly.

18 And it shall be when he sits upon his rule, he shall write for himself this second law into a book from the Levitical priests,

19 and it shall be with him, and he shall read in it all the days of his life, so that he may learn to fear the Lord his God, to guard all these commandments and to do these ordinances,

20 so that his heart may not be raised above his brothers, so that he may not transgress from the commandments right or left, that he and his sons may live long in his rule among the sons of Israel.

Chapter 18

1 The priests, the Levites, the whole tribe of Levi, shall have no portion or allotment with Israel. The Lord’s fruit-offerings are their allotment; they shall eat them.

2 But they shall have no allotment among their brothers; the Lord himself is his allotment, just as he said to him.

3 And this is the judgment for the priests, the things from the people, from those sacrificing the sacrifices, whether a calf or a sheep: he shall give to the priest the arm and the jaws and the stomach.

4 And the firstfruits of your wheat and your wine and your oil and the firstfruit of the shearings of your sheep you shall give to him,

5 because the Lord your God chose him from all your tribes to stand before the Lord your God to minister and to bless in his name, he and his sons among the sons of Israel. –

6 But if the Levite comes from one of your cities, from among all the sons of Israel, where he sojourns, as his soul desires, to the place that the Lord may choose,

7 then he shall minister in the name of the Lord his God like all his brothers the Levites who stand there before the Lord.

8 An apportioned portion he shall eat, apart from the sale according to family.

9 But if you enter the land that the Lord your God is giving you, you shall not learn to do according to the abominations of those nations.

10 There shall not be found among you one purifying his son or his daughter in fire, one divining a divination, one taking omens from utterances and one auguring, a sorcerer,

11 one chanting a charm, a belly-speaker and an observer of portents, one questioning the dead.

12 For everyone doing these things is an abomination to the Lord your God, and because of these abominations the Lord shall utterly destroy them from you.

13 You shall be complete before the Lord your God.

14 For these nations, whom you are inheriting, will listen to omens and divinations, but to you the Lord your God has not given thus.

15 A prophet from your brothers like me the Lord your God shall raise up for you; you shall listen to him

16 according to all that you asked from the Lord your God at Choreb on the day of the assembly, saying: We shall not add to hear the voice of the Lord our God, and we shall not see this great fire any longer, nor shall we die.

17 And the Lord said to me: All that they spoke is right.

18 I shall raise up for them a prophet from their brothers like you and put my word in his mouth, and he shall speak to them according to all that I may command him.

19 And the man who does not listen to all that the prophet may speak in my name, I shall exact it from him.

20 Except the prophet who may act impiously to speak in my name a word that I did not command him to speak, and who may speak in the name of other gods: that prophet shall die.

21 But if you say in your heart: How shall we know the word that the Lord did not speak?

22 Whatever the prophet may speak in the name of the Lord, and the word does not happen and does not come about, this is the word that the Lord did not speak. That prophet spoke in impiety; you shall not keep away from him.

Chapter 19

1 But if the Lord your God makes disappear the nations whose land your God is giving you, and you inherit them and dwell in their cities and in their houses,

2 you shall set apart three cities for yourself in the midst of your land that the Lord your God is giving you.

3 Measure out the road for yourself and divide into three the borders of your land that the Lord your God divides for you, and there shall be refuge there for every killer.

4 And this shall be the command concerning the killer who may flee there and live: whoever strikes his neighbor involuntarily, not having hated him before yesterday and before the third day,

5 and whoever enters the thicket with his neighbor to gather wood, and his hand is knocked away with the axe while cutting the wood, and the iron, falling out from the wood, happens upon his neighbor and he dies, this one shall flee to one of these cities and live,

6 lest the near kinsman of the blood pursue after the killer, because his heart is overheated, and overtake him if the road is longer, and strike his soul, and he dies, though for this man there is no judgment of death, because he had not hated him before yesterday and before the third day.

7 Because of this I command you this word, saying: Three cities you shall set apart for yourself.

8 But if the Lord your God widens your borders in the manner that he swore to your fathers, and the Lord gives you all the land that he said he would give to your fathers,

9 if you listen to do all these commandments that I command you today, to love the Lord your God, to walk in all his ways all the days, then you shall add for yourself three more cities to these three,

10 and innocent blood shall not be poured out in your land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment, and you shall not be liable for blood.

11 But if there comes to be a man hating his neighbor, and he lies in wait for him and rises against him and strikes his soul, and he dies, and the man flees to one of these cities,

12 then the council of elders of his city shall send and take him from there and hand him into the hands of the near kinsman of the blood, and he shall die.

13 Your eye shall not spare him, and you shall cleanse the innocent blood from Israel, and it shall be well for you.

14 You shall not move the boundaries of your neighbor that your fathers set in your inheritance, which you inherited in the land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment.

15 One witness shall not stand to testify against a person concerning any injustice and concerning any wrongdoing and concerning any sin that he may sin. Upon the mouth of two witnesses and upon the mouth of three witnesses every matter shall stand.

16 But if an unjust witness takes his stand against a person, recounting his impiety,

17 then the two men who have the dispute shall stand before the Lord and before the priests and before the judges who may be in those days,

18 and the judges shall examine carefully, and behold, an unjust witness has testified unjustly; he stood against his brother,

19 and you shall do to him in the manner that he acted wickedly to do against his brother, and you shall remove the evil one from among you yourselves.

20 And those remaining, hearing, shall fear and shall not add still more to do according to this evil matter among you.

21 Your eye shall not spare him: soul for soul, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.

Chapter 20

1 But if you go out to war against your enemies and see horse and rider and a people more numerous than you, you shall not fear them, because the Lord your God is with you, the one who brought you up from the land of Egypt.

2 And it shall be when you draw near to the war, the priest, drawing near, shall speak to the people

3 and say to them: Hear, Israel. You are going today to war against your enemies. Let not your heart be weakened; do not fear or be shattered or turn aside from before their face,

4 because the Lord your God goes before with you to fight together with you against your enemies, to rescue you.

5 And the scribes shall speak to the people, saying: Who is the man who built a new house and has not inaugurated it? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the war and another man inaugurate it.

6 And who is the man who planted a vineyard and has not rejoiced from it? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the war and another man rejoice from it.

7 And who is the man who has betrothed a woman and has not taken her? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the war and another man take her.

8 And the scribes shall add to speak to the people and say: Who is the man who is afraid and cowardly in heart? Let him go and return to his house, so that he may not make the heart of his brother cowardly like his own.

9 And it shall be when the scribes cease speaking to the people, they shall appoint rulers of the army leading the people.

10 But if you approach a city to make war against it and call them out with peace,

11 If they answer you peaceably and open to you, then all the people found in it shall be subject to tribute for you and obedient to you.

12 But if they do not obey you and make war against you, you shall besiege it,

13 and the Lord your God shall hand it into your hands, and you shall strike every male of it with slaughter by the sword,

14 except the women and the baggage and all the livestock and everything that may be in the city; and all the equipment you shall plunder for yourself, and you shall eat all the plunder of your enemies that the Lord your God is giving you.

15 Thus you shall do to all the cities that are very far from you, which are not from the cities of these nations.

16 But behold, from the cities of these nations whose land the Lord your God is giving you to inherit, you shall not capture alive from them anything breathing,

17 but with an anathema you shall anathematize them: the Chettite and Amorrite and Chanaanite and Pherezite and Evite and Jebousite and Gergesite, in the manner that the Lord your God commanded you,

18 so that they may not teach you to do all their abominations that they did for their gods, and you shall sin before the Lord your God.

19 But if you sit around a city for many days to make war against it for its capture, you shall not utterly destroy its trees by laying iron upon them; rather, you shall eat from it, but you shall not cut it down. Is the tree in the field a human to enter from before your face into the palisade?

20 But a tree that you know is not fruit-eatable, this you shall utterly destroy and cut down and build a palisade against the city that makes war against you, until it is handed over.

Chapter 21

1 But if a wounded person is found in the land that the Lord your God is giving you to inherit, fallen in the plain, and they do not know who struck him,

2 your council of elders and your judges shall go out and measure to the cities around the wounded person,

3 and it shall be the city nearest the wounded person; the council of elders of that city shall take a heifer from the cattle that has not worked and has not drawn a yoke,

4 and the council of elders of that city shall bring the heifer down into a rugged ravine that has not been worked or sown, and they shall cut the sinews of the heifer in the ravine.

5 And the priests, the Levites, shall come near – because the Lord your God chose them to stand beside him and to bless upon his name, and upon their mouth shall be every dispute and every touch – ,

6 and all the council of elders of that city, those nearest the wounded person, shall wash their hands upon the head of the heifer whose sinews were cut in the ravine,

7 and answering they shall say: Our hands did not pour out this blood, and our eyes have not seen.

8 Be gracious to your people Israel, whom you redeemed, Lord, from the land of Egypt, so that innocent blood may not come to be among your people Israel. And the blood shall be atoned for them.

9 But you shall remove the innocent blood from among you yourselves if you do what is good and pleasing before the Lord your God.

10 But if you go out to war against your enemies and the Lord your God hands them into your hands and you plunder their plunder

11 and see among the plunder a woman beautiful in appearance and set your mind on her and take her for yourself as a wife,

12 you shall bring her inside into your house and shave her head and pare her nails

13 and remove the garments of her captivity from her, and she shall sit in your house and weep for her father and mother a month of days, and after these things you shall enter to her and dwell together with her, and she shall be your wife.

14 And it shall be if you do not want her, you shall send her out free, and by sale she shall not be sold for silver. You shall not disregard her, because you humbled her.

15 But if a man comes to have two wives, one of them loved and one of them hated, and the loved and the hated bear children to him, and a firstborn son comes to be of the hated one,

16 then it shall be on whatever day he allots his possessions as an inheritance to his sons, he shall not be able to make the loved one’s son firstborn, overlooking the firstborn son of the hated one,

17 but he shall recognize the firstborn son of the hated one, to give him double from everything that may be found for him, because this one is the beginning of his children, and the firstborn rights belong to him.

18 But if someone has a son disobedient and a provoker, not obeying the voice of his father and the voice of his mother, and they discipline him and he does not listen to them,

19 then his father and his mother shall take hold of him and bring him out to the council of elders of his city and to the gate of his place

20 and say to the men of their city: This son of ours disobeys and provokes, does not obey our voice; feasting at banquets, he is drunk with wine.

21 And the men of his city shall stone him with stones, and he shall die; and you shall remove the evil one from among you yourselves, and those remaining, hearing, shall fear.

22 But if there comes to be in someone a sin, a judgment of death, and he dies and you hang him on wood,

23 his body shall not sleep overnight on the wood, but with burial you shall bury him on that day, because everyone hanging on wood is cursed by God; and you shall not defile the land that the Lord your God is giving you as an allotment.

Chapter 22

1 Do not, upon seeing your brother’s calf or his sheep wandering on the road, overlook them. By turning you shall turn them back to your brother and return them to him.

2 But if your brother is not near you and you do not know him, you shall gather them inside into your house, and they shall be with you until your brother seeks them, and you shall return them to him.

3 Thus you shall do for his donkey, and thus you shall do for his garment, and thus you shall do for every loss of your brother, whatever may be lost by him and you find; you shall not be able to overlook it. –

4 Do not, when you see your brother’s donkey or his calf fallen on the road, overlook them; by raising you shall raise them with him.

5 The gear of a man shall not be upon a woman, nor shall a man ever put on a woman’s robe, because everyone doing these things is an abomination to the Lord your God.

6 But if you encounter a nest of birds before your face on the road or on any tree or on the ground, with chicks or eggs, and the mother warms the chicks or the eggs, you shall not take the mother with the children.

7 By sending you shall send the mother away, but you shall take the children for yourself, so that it may become well for you and you may be long-lived.

8 But if you build a new house, you shall make a crown for your roof; and you shall not cause a killing in your house if the one falling falls from it.

9 You shall not sow your vineyard with something different, lest the yield and the seed that you sow together with the yield of your vineyard be sanctified. –

10 You shall not plow with a calf and a donkey together. –

11 You shall not put on adulterated cloth, wool and linen together.

12 You shall make twisted cords for yourself on the four borders of your coverings with which you may cover yourself.

13 But if someone takes a woman and lives with her and hates her

14 and places pretextual words upon her and brings an evil name upon her and says: I took this woman and, coming to her, did not find signs of her virginity,

15 then the girl’s father and mother shall take and bring out the signs of the girl’s virginity to the council of elders at the gate,

16 and the girl’s father shall say to the council of elders: I gave this daughter of mine to this man as a wife, and he, hating her,

17 now places pretextual words upon her, saying: I did not find signs of virginity in your daughter. And these are the signs of my daughter’s virginity. And they shall unfold the garment before the council of elders of the city.

18 And the council of elders of that city shall take that man and discipline him

19 and fine him a hundred shekels and give them to the father of the young woman, because he brought an evil name upon an Israelite virgin; and she shall be his wife, and he shall not be able to send her out for all time.

20 But if this matter truly comes to be and signs of virginity are not found for the young woman,

21 then they shall bring the young woman out to the doors of her father’s house, and the men of her city shall stone her with stones, and she shall die, because she did a senseless thing among the sons of Israel by prostituting her father’s house; and you shall remove the evil one from among you yourselves.

22 But if a man is found lying with a woman who lives together with a man, you shall kill both, the man lying with the woman and the woman; and you shall remove the evil one from Israel.

23 But if there comes to be a virgin girl betrothed to a man, and a man finding her in a city lies with her,

24 you shall bring both out to the gate of their city, and they shall be stoned with stones and die: the young woman because she did not cry out in the city, and the man because he humbled the wife of his neighbor; and you shall remove the evil one from among you yourselves. –

25 But if a man finds the betrothed girl in the plain and, using force, lies with her, you shall kill only the man who lay with her,

26 and you shall do nothing to the young woman; there is no sin of death in the young woman, because as if a man rose against his neighbor and murdered his soul, so is this matter,

27 because he found her in the field; the betrothed young woman cried out, and there was no one to help her.

28 But if someone finds a virgin girl who is not betrothed and, using force, lies with her and is found,

29 the man who lay with her shall give the young woman’s father fifty didrachmas of silver, and she shall be his wife, because he humbled her; he shall not be able to send her out for all time.

Chapter 23

1 A man shall not take his father’s wife, and he shall not uncover his father’s covering.

2 A man with crushed parts and one who has been cut off shall not enter the assembly of the Lord.

3 One from a prostitute shall not enter the assembly of the Lord.

4 An Ammanite and a Moabite shall not enter the assembly of the Lord; even to the tenth generation he shall not enter the assembly of the Lord, even forever,

5 because they did not meet you with bread and water on the way when you were going out from Egypt, and because they hired Balaam son of Beor from Mesopotamia against you to curse you;

6 and the Lord your God did not wish to listen to Balaam, and the Lord your God turned the curses into blessing, because the Lord your God loved you.

7 You shall not address peaceful things to them and things advantageous to them all your days, forever.

8 You shall not abhor an Idumaean, because he is your brother; you shall not abhor an Egyptian, because you became a sojourner in his land;

9 if sons are born to them, in the third generation they shall enter the assembly of the Lord.

10 And if you go out to encamp against your enemies, you shall guard yourself from every evil word.

11 If there is among you a man who is not clean because of his discharge by night, he shall go outside the camp and shall not enter the camp;

12 and it shall be that toward evening he shall wash his body with water, and when the sun has set he shall enter the camp.

13 And you shall have a place outside the camp, and you shall go out there;

14 and you shall have a peg on your belt, and it shall be that when you sit down outside, you shall dig with it and, bringing the earth back, cover your indecency with it;

15 because the Lord your God walks about in your camp to deliver you and to hand over your enemy before your face; and your camp shall be holy, and an indecency of a thing shall not be seen among you, and he shall turn away from you.

16 You shall not hand over to his master a servant who has joined himself to you from his master;

17 he shall dwell with you, he shall dwell among you in every place wherever it pleases him; you shall not afflict him.

18 There shall not be a prostitute from the daughters of Israel, and there shall not be a man prostituting himself from the sons of Israel; there shall not be a female bearer of rites from the daughters of Israel, and there shall not be a man being initiated from the sons of Israel.

19 You shall not bring the hire of a prostitute nor the exchange of a dog into the house of the Lord your God for any vow, because both are an abomination to the Lord your God.

20 You shall not lend at interest to your brother interest on silver or interest on food or interest on anything that you lend;

21 to the foreigner you shall lend at interest, but to your brother you shall not lend at interest, so that the Lord your God may bless you in all your works upon the land into which you are entering there to inherit it.

22 And if you vow a vow to the Lord your God, you shall not delay to pay it, because the Lord your God will surely require it of you, and there shall be sin in you;

23 but if you do not wish to vow, there is no sin in you.

24 What goes forth through your lips you shall guard and do, in the manner that you vowed a gift to the Lord your God, which you spoke with your mouth.

25 And if you enter your neighbor’s harvest, you shall gather ears with your hands, but you shall certainly not put a sickle to your neighbor’s harvest. –

26 And if you enter your neighbor’s vineyard, you may eat grapes as much as to fill your soul, but you shall not put any into a vessel.

Chapter 24

1 And if someone takes a wife and lives with her, and it comes to pass that she does not find favor before him because he has found an indecent thing in her, he shall write her a document of separation and give it into her hands and send her out of his house,

2 and she, having gone away, becomes another man’s wife,

3 and the latter man hates her and writes her a document of separation and gives it into her hands and sends her out of his house, or the latter man who took her for himself as a wife dies,

4 the former man who sent her out shall not be able to turn back and take her for himself as a wife after she has been defiled, because it is an abomination before the Lord your God; and you shall not defile the land that the Lord your God gives you as an inheritance.

5 And if someone takes a wife recently, he shall not go out to war, and no matter shall be laid upon him; he shall be free in his house for one year; he shall gladden his wife whom he took.

6 You shall not take a mill or an upper millstone as a pledge, because this takes a life as a pledge.

7 And if a man is caught stealing a person from his brothers, the sons of Israel, and, having oppressed him, sells him, that thief shall die; and you shall remove the evil from among yourselves.

8 Take heed to yourself in the affliction of leprosy; you shall be very careful to do according to all the law that the priests, the Levites, announce to you; as I commanded you, take care to do.

9 Remember all that the Lord your God did to Mariam on the way when you were going out from Egypt.

10 If there is a debt with your neighbor, any debt whatever, you shall not enter his house to take the pledge as a pledge;

11 you shall stand outside, and the man with whom your loan rests shall bring the pledge out to you.

12 And if the man is poor, you shall not sleep with his pledge;

13 you shall certainly give back his pledge around sunset, and he shall sleep in his garment and bless you, and it shall be mercy for you before the Lord your God.

14 You shall not wrong the wage of a poor and needy person from your brothers or from the sojourners in your cities;

15 on the same day you shall pay his wage; the sun shall not set upon it, because he is poor and has his hope in it; and he shall not cry out against you to the Lord, and there shall be sin in you.

16 Fathers shall not die for children, and sons shall not die for fathers; each shall die for his own sin.

17 You shall not turn aside the judgment of a sojourner and an orphan and a widow, and you shall not take a widow’s garment as a pledge;

18 and you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt and the Lord your God redeemed you from there; therefore I command you to do this thing.

19 And if you reap a harvest in your field and forget a sheaf in your field, you shall not go back to take it; it shall be for the poor person and the sojourner and the orphan and the widow, so that the Lord your God may bless you in all the works of your hands.

20 And if you gather olives, you shall not go back to glean what is behind you; it shall be for the sojourner and the orphan and the widow; and you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt; therefore I command you to do this thing.

21 And if you gather grapes from your vineyard, you shall not go back to gather the grapes behind you; it shall be for the sojourner and the orphan and the widow;

22 and you shall remember that you were a household servant in the land of Egypt; therefore I command you to do this thing.

Chapter 25

1 And if a dispute arises between people and they come to judgment, and they judge and justify the righteous and condemn the ungodly,

2 and it shall be, if the one acting ungodly is worthy of blows, you shall set him down before the judges, and they shall whip him before them according to his ungodliness, by number.

3 They shall whip him forty times; they shall not add to it. But if they add to whipping him more blows beyond these, your brother shall be disgraced before you.

4 You shall not muzzle an ox while it is threshing.

5 And if brothers dwell together and one of them dies, and he has no offspring, the wife of the dead man shall not be for an outside man who is not near; her husband’s brother shall go in to her and take her for himself as a wife and live with her.

6 And it shall be that the child whom she bears shall be established under the name of the one who has died, and his name shall not be wiped out from Israel.

7 But if the man does not wish to take his brother’s wife, the woman shall go up to the gate to the council of elders and say, “My husband’s brother does not wish to raise up his brother’s name in Israel; my husband’s brother did not wish to.”

8 And the council of elders of his city shall call him and speak to him, and standing he says, “I do not wish to take her,”

9 then his brother’s wife shall come forward before the council of elders and loosen his one sandal from his foot and spit in his face, and answering she shall say, “Thus they shall do to the man who will not build up his brother’s house”;

10 and his name shall be called in Israel “House of the one whose sandal was loosened.”

11 And if people fight together, a man with his brother, and the wife of one of them comes forward to rescue her husband from the hand of the one striking him, and stretching out her hand takes hold of his testicles,

12 you shall cut off her hand; your eye shall not spare her.

13 There shall not be in your purse a weight and a weight, large or small;

14 there shall not be in your house a measure and a measure, large or small;

15 you shall have a true and just weight, and you shall have a true and just measure, so that you may become long-lived upon the land that the Lord your God gives you as an inheritance;

16 because everyone doing these things, everyone doing injustice, is an abomination to the Lord your God.

17 Remember all that Amalek did to you on the way when you were going out from Egypt,

18 how he opposed you on the way and cut off your rear guard, those who were weary behind you, while you were hungry and weary; and he did not fear God.

19 And it shall be, when the Lord your God gives you rest from all your enemies around you in the land that the Lord your God gives you as an inheritance to inherit, you shall wipe out the name of Amalek from under heaven, and you shall certainly not forget.

Chapter 26

1 And it shall be, if you enter the land that the Lord your God gives you as an inheritance and inherit it and dwell upon it,

2 you shall take from the first fruits of the fruit of your land that the Lord your God gives you and put it into a basket and go to the place that the Lord your God chooses for his name to be called there,

3 and you shall come to the priest who is in those days and say to him, “I declare today to the Lord my God that I have entered the land that the Lord swore to our fathers to give to us.”

4 And the priest shall take the basket from your hands and place it before the altar of the Lord your God,

5 and you shall answer and say before the Lord your God, “My father cast off Syria and went down into Egypt and sojourned there with a small number, and there he became a great nation and a numerous and great multitude;

6 and the Egyptians afflicted us and humbled us and laid hard works upon us;

7 and we cried aloud to the Lord, the God of our fathers, and the Lord listened to our voice and saw our humiliation and our toil and our affliction;

8 and the Lord himself brought us out of Egypt with great strength and with a mighty hand and with his uplifted arm and with great visions and with signs and with wonders,

9 and brought us into this place and gave us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey;

10 and now, behold, I have brought the first fruits of the produce of the land that you gave me, Lord, a land flowing with milk and honey.” And you shall leave them before the Lord your God and bow down there before the Lord your God;

11 and you shall rejoice in all the good things that the Lord your God gave to you and your household, you and the Levite and the sojourner among you.

12 And if you finish tithing all the tenth part of the produce of your land in the third year, you shall give the second tenth part to the Levite and to the sojourner and to the orphan and to the widow, and they shall eat in your cities and be filled.

13 And you shall say before the Lord your God, “I have cleared the holy things out of my house and given them to the Levite and the sojourner and the orphan and the widow according to all the commandments that you commanded me; I did not transgress your commandment and I did not forget;

14 and I did not eat of them in my pain, nor did I make use of any of them for an unclean thing, nor did I give any of them to the dead; I obeyed the voice of the Lord my God; I did as you commanded me.

15 Look down from your holy house, from heaven, and bless your people Israel and the land that you gave them, as you swore to our fathers to give to us a land flowing with milk and honey.”

16 On this day the Lord your God commanded you to do all these ordinances and judgments, and you shall guard and do them with all your heart and with all your soul.

17 You chose God today to be your God and to walk in his ways and to guard his ordinances and his judgments and to obey his voice;

18 and the Lord chose you today to become for him a special people, just as he said to you, to guard all his commandments,

19 and for you to be above all the nations, as he made you renowned and a boast and glorified, for you to be a holy people to the Lord your God, as he spoke.

Chapter 27

1 And Moses and the council of elders of Israel commanded, saying, “Guard all these commandments that I command you today.

2 And it shall be on the day when you cross the Jordan into the land that the Lord your God gives you, you shall set up large stones for yourself and plaster them with plaster

3 and write upon the stones all the words of this law when you cross the Jordan, when you enter the land that the Lord, the God of your fathers, gives you, a land flowing with milk and honey, as the Lord, the God of your fathers, said to you;

4 and it shall be, when you cross the Jordan, you shall set up these stones that I command you today on Mount Gaibal and plaster them with plaster.

5 And you shall build there an altar to the Lord your God, an altar of stones; you shall not put iron upon them;

6 with whole stones you shall build an altar to the Lord your God and offer upon it whole burnt offerings to the Lord your God,

7 and you shall sacrifice there a sacrifice of salvation to the Lord your God and eat and be filled and rejoice before the Lord your God.

8 And you shall write upon the stones all this law very clearly.”

9 And Moses and the priests, the Levites, spoke to all Israel, saying, “Be silent and hear, Israel; on this day you have become a people to the Lord your God;

10 and you shall listen to the voice of the Lord your God and do all his commandments and his ordinances that I command you today.”

11 And Moses commanded the people on that day, saying,

12 “These shall stand to bless the people on Mount Garizin, having crossed the Jordan: Symeon, Levi, Judas, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin.

13 And these shall stand for the curse on Mount Gaibal: Reuben, Gad and Aser, Zabulon, Dan and Nephthali.”

14 And the Levites shall answer and say to all Israel with a loud voice,

15 “Accursed is the man who makes a carved and cast thing, an abomination to the Lord, the work of a craftsman’s hands, and places it in secret.” And all the people shall answer and say, “May it be so.”

16 “Accursed is the one who dishonors his father or his mother.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

17 “Accursed is the one who moves the boundaries of his neighbor.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

18 “Accursed is the one who leads a blind person astray on the road.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

19 “Accursed is whoever turns aside the judgment of a sojourner and an orphan and a widow.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

20 “Accursed is the one who sleeps with his father’s wife, because he uncovered his father’s covering.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

21 “Accursed is the one who sleeps with any animal.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

22 “Accursed is the one who sleeps with his sister from his father or from his mother.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

23 “Accursed is the one who sleeps with his mother-in-law.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.” “Accursed is the one who sleeps with his wife’s sister.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

24 “Accursed is the one who strikes his neighbor deceitfully.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

25 “Accursed is whoever takes gifts to strike a person of innocent blood.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

26 “Accursed is every person who does not remain in all the words of this law to do them.” And all the people shall say, “May it be so.”

Chapter 28

1 And it shall be when you cross the Jordan into the land that the Lord your God gives you, if you diligently listen to the voice of the Lord your God to guard and do all his commandments that I command you today, the Lord your God will set you above all the nations of the earth,

2 and all these blessings shall come upon you and find you if you listen to the voice of the Lord your God.

3 Blessed are you in the city, and blessed are you in the field;

4 blessed are the offspring of your womb and the produce of your land, the herds of your cattle and the flocks of your sheep;

5 blessed are your storehouses and what you leave behind;

6 blessed are you when you enter, and blessed are you when you go out.

7 May the Lord your God hand over your enemies who oppose you, broken before your face; by one road they shall come out against you and by seven roads they shall flee from before your face.

8 May the Lord send the blessing upon you in your storerooms and in everything to which you put your hand, upon the land that the Lord your God gives you.

9 May the Lord your God establish you for himself as a holy people, as he swore to your fathers, if you listen to the voice of the Lord your God and walk in his ways;

10 and all the nations of the earth shall see you, that the name of the Lord has been called upon you, and they shall fear you.

11 And the Lord your God shall multiply you for good in the offspring of your womb and in the produce of your land and in the offspring of your animals upon the land that the Lord swore to your fathers to give you.

12 May the Lord open to you his good treasure, heaven, to give rain to your land in its season, to bless all the works of your hands; and you shall lend to many nations, but you shall not borrow, and you shall rule many nations, but they shall not rule you.

13 May the Lord your God set you as head and not as tail, and you shall then be above and shall not be below, if you listen to the commandments of the Lord your God that I command you today to guard and do;

14 you shall not turn aside from any of the words that I command you today, right or left, to go after other gods to serve them.

15 And it shall be, if you do not listen to the voice of the Lord your God to guard and do all his commandments that I command you today, all these curses shall come upon you and overtake you.

16 Accursed are you in the city, and accursed are you in the field;

17 accursed are your storehouses and what you leave behind;

18 accursed are the offspring of your womb and the produce of your land, the herds of your cattle and the flocks of your sheep;

19 accursed are you when you go out, and accursed are you when you enter.

20 May the Lord send upon you want and famine and consumption in everything to which you put your hand, whatever you do, until he destroys you and until he causes you to perish quickly because of your evil practices, because you forsook me.

21 May the Lord make death cling to you until he consumes you from the land into which you are entering to inherit it.

22 May the Lord strike you with distress and fever and chills and inflammation and slaughter and wind-blight and pallor, and they shall pursue you until they destroy you.

23 And the heaven over your head shall be bronze, and the earth beneath you iron.

24 May the Lord give dust as the rain of your land, and earth shall come down upon you from heaven until he wears you away and until he destroys you.

25 May the Lord give you defeat before your enemies; by one road you shall go out against them and by seven roads you shall flee from before their face; and you shall be scattered among all the kingdoms of the earth.

26 And your dead shall be food for the birds of heaven and the beasts of the earth, and there shall be no one to drive them away.

27 May the Lord strike you with an Egyptian sore on the seats of the body, and with wild scab and itching, so that you cannot be healed.

28 May the Lord strike you with paralysis and blindness and derangement of mind,

29 and you shall be groping at midday as a blind person gropes in darkness, and your ways shall not prosper; and you shall then be wronged and plundered all your days, and there shall be no one to help you.

30 You shall take a wife, and another man shall have her; you shall build a house and shall not dwell in it; you shall plant a vineyard and shall not gather its grapes;

31 your calf shall be slaughtered before you, and you shall not eat of it; your donkey shall be snatched away from you and shall not be returned to you; your sheep shall be given to your enemies, and there shall be no one to help you;

32 your sons and daughters shall be given to another nation, and your eyes shall look toward them, wasting away, and your hand shall have no strength;

33 the produce of your land and all your labors a nation that you do not know shall eat, and you shall be wronged and crushed all your days;

34 and you shall be deranged because of the sights of your eyes that you see.

35 May the Lord strike you with an evil sore on the knees and on the shins so that you cannot be healed, from the sole of your feet to your crown.

36 May the Lord lead you and your rulers whom you set over yourself away to a nation that you and your fathers do not know, and there you shall serve other gods, wood and stones.

37 And there you shall be a riddle and a parable and a tale among all the nations to which the Lord leads you away.

38 You shall carry much seed out to the plain and bring little in, because the locust shall devour it.

39 You shall plant a vineyard and cultivate it and shall not drink wine or rejoice from it, because the worm shall devour it.

40 You shall have olives within all your borders, and you shall not anoint yourself with oil, because your olive shall fall off.

41 You shall beget sons and daughters, and they shall not be yours, for they shall go away into captivity.

42 Rust shall consume all your trees and the produce of your land.

43 The sojourner who is among you shall rise above you, higher and higher, but you shall descend lower and lower;

44 he shall lend to you, but you shall not lend to him; he shall be head, but you shall be tail.

45 And all these curses shall come upon you and pursue you and overtake you until he destroys you and until he causes you to perish, because you did not listen to the voice of the Lord your God to guard his commandments and his ordinances that he commanded you.

46 And they shall be among you as signs and wonders, and among your offspring forever,

47 because you did not serve the Lord your God with joy and a good heart on account of the abundance of all things.

48 And you shall serve your enemies whom the Lord will send upon you, in famine and in thirst and in nakedness and in lack of all things; and he shall put an iron collar upon your neck until he destroys you.

49 The Lord shall bring against you a nation from afar, from the end of the earth, like the swoop of an eagle, a nation whose voice you shall not hear,

50 a nation shameless in face, which shall not regard the face of an old person and shall not have mercy on a young person,

51 and it shall devour the offspring of your animals and the produce of your land, leaving you neither grain nor wine nor oil, the herds of your cattle nor the flocks of your sheep, until it causes you to perish

52 and wears you away in all your cities until your high and fortified walls in which you trust are torn down throughout all your land; and it shall afflict you in all your cities that the Lord your God gave you.

53 And you shall eat the offspring of your womb, the flesh of your sons and daughters whom the Lord your God gave you, in your confinement and your affliction with which your enemy shall afflict you.

54 The tender and very delicate man among you shall look with an evil eye upon his brother and the wife in his bosom and the children left to him,

55 so as to give one of them some of the flesh of his children that he eats, because nothing is left to him in your confinement and your affliction with which your enemies shall afflict you in all your cities.

56 And the tender and very delicate woman among you, whose foot has not had experience treading upon the ground because of delicacy and tenderness, shall look with an evil eye upon her husband in her bosom and upon her son and her daughter

57 and her afterbirth that comes out from between her thighs and the child whom she bears; for she shall eat them secretly because of the lack of all things in your confinement and your affliction with which your enemy shall afflict you in all your cities.

58 If you do not listen to do all the words of this law written in this book, to fear this honored and wonderful name, the Lord your God,

59 then the Lord shall make your blows and the blows of your offspring extraordinary, great and wonderful blows, and evil and lasting diseases;

60 and he shall turn back upon you every evil pain of Egypt that you dreaded before them, and they shall cling to you.

61 And every sickness and every blow not written in the book of this law the Lord shall bring upon you until he destroys you.

62 And you shall be left few in number, whereas you were like the stars of heaven in multitude, because you did not listen to the voice of the Lord your God.

63 And it shall be, in the manner that the Lord rejoiced over you to do you good and multiply you, so the Lord shall rejoice over you to destroy you, and you shall be removed from the land into which you are entering to inherit it.

64 And the Lord your God shall scatter you among all the nations, from one end of the earth to the other end of the earth, and there you shall serve other gods, wood and stones, which neither you nor your fathers knew.

65 But also among those nations he shall not give you rest, nor shall there be a standing place for the sole of your foot, and the Lord shall give you there a disheartened heart and failing eyes and a melting soul.

66 And your life shall hang before your eyes, and you shall be afraid day and night and shall not trust in your life;

67 in the morning you shall say, “How might it become evening?” and in the evening you shall say, “How might it become morning?” because of the fear of your heart that you shall fear and because of the sights of your eyes that you shall see.

68 And the Lord shall turn you back to Egypt in ships and on the road of which I said, “You shall not again see it”; and there you shall be sold to your enemies as male and female servants, and there shall be no buyer.

69 These are the words of the covenant that the Lord commanded Moses to establish for the sons of Israel in the land of Moab, besides the covenant that he made with them at Choreb.

Chapter 29

1 And Moses called all the sons of Israel and said to them, “You have seen all that the Lord did in the land of Egypt before you to Pharaoh and his attendants and all his land,

2 the great trials that your eyes have seen, those great signs and wonders;

3 and the Lord God has not given you a heart to know and eyes to see and ears to hear until this day.

4 And he led you forty years in the wilderness; your garments did not grow old, and your sandals were not worn away from your feet;

5 you did not eat bread, you did not drink wine and strong drink, so that you might know that this is the Lord your God.

6 And you came as far as this place, and Seon king of Esebon and Og king of Basan came out to meet us in war, and we struck them

7 and took their land, and I gave it as an inheritance to Reuben and Gaddi and the half tribe of Manasse.

8 And you shall take care to do all the words of this covenant, so that you may understand all that you do.

9 You all stand today before the Lord your God, your tribal chiefs and your council of elders and your judges and your scribal instructors, every man of Israel,

10 your women and your offspring and the sojourner in the midst of your camp, from your woodcutter to your water carrier,

11 to enter into the covenant of the Lord your God and into his curses, which the Lord your God is making with you today,

12 so that he may establish you for himself as a people, and he shall be your God, as he said to you and as he swore to your fathers Abraham and Isaac and Jacob.

13 And it is not with you alone that I make this covenant and this curse,

14 but also with those who are here with us today before the Lord your God and those who are not here with us today.

15 For you know how we dwelt in the land of Egypt and passed through the midst of the nations through which you passed,

16 and you saw their abominations and their idols, wood and stone, silver and gold, which are among them.

17 Is there perhaps among you a man or woman or family or tribe whose mind has turned away from the Lord your God to go and serve the gods of those nations? Is there perhaps among you a root growing upward in gall and bitterness?

18 And it shall be, if he hears the words of this curse and blesses himself in his heart, saying, “May holy things be mine, because I shall walk in the wandering of my heart,” so that the sinner may not destroy the sinless one along with him,

19 God will certainly not wish to be gracious to him; rather, then the anger of the Lord and his zeal shall burn against that man, and all the curses of this covenant written in this book of the law shall cling to him, and the Lord shall wipe out his name from under heaven;

20 and the Lord shall set him apart for evil from all the sons of Israel according to all the curses of the covenant written in this book of the law.

21 And the other generation, your sons who shall rise after you, and the foreigner who comes from a distant land shall speak, and they shall see the blows upon that land and its diseases that the Lord sent upon it –

22 sulfur and salt, burned; all its land shall not be sown nor sprout, nor shall any green thing grow upon it, as Sodom and Gomorra, Adama and Seboim were overthrown, which the Lord overthrew in fury and anger –

23 and all the nations shall say, “Why did the Lord do thus to this land? What is this great fury of anger?”

24 And they shall say, “Because they abandoned the covenant of the Lord, the God of their fathers, which he made with their fathers when he brought them out of the land of Egypt,

25 and they went and served other gods and bowed down to them, whom they did not know and whom he had not allotted to them;

26 and the Lord was angered in fury against that land, to bring upon it all the curses written in this book of the law,

27 and the Lord removed them from their land in fury and anger and very great provocation and cast them into another land, as now.”

28 The hidden things belong to the Lord our God, but the revealed things to us and to our children forever, to do all the words of this law.

Chapter 30

1 And it shall be when all these words come upon you, the blessing and the curse that I set before your face, and you receive them into your heart among all the nations wherever the Lord scatters you,

2 and you turn to the Lord your God and obey his voice according to all that I command you today with all your heart and with all your soul,

3 then the Lord shall heal your sins and have mercy on you and gather you again from all the nations among which the Lord scattered you.

4 If your dispersion is from one end of heaven to the other end of heaven, from there the Lord your God shall gather you, and from there the Lord your God shall take you;

5 and the Lord your God shall bring you into the land that your fathers inherited, and you shall inherit it; and he shall do you good and make you more numerous than your fathers.

6 And the Lord shall cleanse your heart and the heart of your offspring, to love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul, so that you may live.

7 And the Lord your God shall put these curses upon your enemies and upon those who hate you, who pursued you.

8 And you shall turn and listen to the voice of the Lord your God and do his commandments that I command you today,

9 and the Lord your God shall make you abundant in every work of your hands, in the offspring of your womb and in the produce of your land and in the offspring of your animals; because the Lord your God shall turn again to rejoice over you for good, as he rejoiced over your fathers,

10 if you listen to the voice of the Lord your God to guard and do all his commandments and his ordinances and his judgments written in this book of the law, if you turn to the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul.

11 For this commandment that I command you today is not excessive, nor is it far from you.

12 It is not up in heaven, saying, “Who shall ascend for us into heaven and take it for us? And having heard it, we shall do it.”

13 Nor is it beyond the sea, saying, “Who shall cross over for us to the other side of the sea and take it for us? And he shall make it heard by us, and we shall do it.”

14 The word is very near you, in your mouth and in your heart and in your hands, to do it.

15 Behold, I have set before your face today life and death, good and evil.

16 If you listen to the commandments of the Lord your God that I command you today, to love the Lord your God, to walk in all his ways, to guard his ordinances and his judgments, then you shall live and be many, and the Lord your God shall bless you in all the land into which you are entering to inherit it.

17 But if your heart turns away and you do not listen and, being led astray, bow down to other gods and serve them,

18 I announce to you today that you shall surely perish and shall certainly not become long-lived upon the land that the Lord your God gives you, into which you are crossing the Jordan to inherit it.

19 I call heaven and earth to witness to you today: I have set before your face life and death, blessing and curse; choose life, so that you and your offspring may live,

20 to love the Lord your God, to listen to his voice and to hold fast to him; for this is your life and the length of your days, for you to dwell upon the land that the Lord swore to your fathers Abraham and Isaac and Jacob to give them.

Chapter 31

1 And Moses finished speaking all these words to all the sons of Israel;

2 and he said to them, “I am one hundred and twenty years old today; I can no longer go in and go out, and the Lord said to me, ‘You shall not cross this Jordan.’

3 The Lord your God, who goes before your face, he shall destroy these nations from before your face, and you shall inherit them; and Jesus shall go before your face, as the Lord spoke.

4 And the Lord shall do to them as he did to Seon and Og, the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, and to their land, when he destroyed them.

5 And the Lord has handed them over to you, and you shall do to them as I commanded you.

6 Be manly and strong; do not fear, nor be cowardly, nor be terrified before their face, because the Lord your God, who goes ahead with you among you, shall certainly not let you go nor forsake you.”

7 And Moses called Jesus and said to him before all Israel, “Be manly and strong; for you shall go in before this people into the land that the Lord swore to our fathers to give them, and you shall cause them to inherit it;

8 and the Lord who goes with you shall not let you go nor forsake you; do not fear nor be cowardly.”

9 And Moses wrote the words of this law in a book and gave it to the priests, the sons of Levi who carry the ark of the Lord’s covenant, and to the elders of the sons of Israel.

10 And Moses commanded them on that day, saying, “After seven years, at the time of the year of release, at the feast of the setting up of tents,

11 when all Israel comes together to appear before the Lord your God at the place the Lord chooses, you shall read this law before all Israel in their ears;

12 assemble the people, the men and the women and the offspring and the sojourner in your cities, so that they may hear and learn to fear the Lord your God, and they shall listen to do all the words of this law;

13 and their sons who do not know shall hear and learn to fear the Lord your God all the days that they live upon the land into which you are crossing the Jordan to inherit it.”

14 And the Lord said to Moses, “Behold, the days of your death have drawn near; call Jesus and stand by the doors of the tent of testimony, and I shall command him.” And Moses and Jesus went to the tent of testimony and stood by the doors of the tent of testimony.

15 And the Lord came down in a cloud and stood by the doors of the tent of testimony, and the pillar of cloud stood by the doors of the tent.

16 And the Lord said to Moses, “Behold, you are sleeping with your fathers, and this people shall arise and prostitute themselves after foreign gods of the land into which they are entering, and they shall forsake me and scatter my covenant that I made with them.

17 And I shall be angered in fury against them on that day and forsake them and turn my face away from them, and the people shall become food, and many evils and afflictions shall find him; and he shall say on that day, ‘Because the Lord my God is not among me, these evils have found me.’

18 But I shall surely turn my face away from them on that day because of all the wicked things they did, because they turned to foreign gods.

19 And now write the words of this song and teach it to the sons of Israel and put it into their mouth, so that this song may be a witness for me among the sons of Israel.

20 For I shall bring them into the good land that I swore to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey, and they shall eat and, being filled, be sated; and they shall turn to foreign gods and serve them and provoke me and scatter my covenant.

21 And this song shall stand against them, testifying before their face, for it shall not be forgotten from their mouth and from the mouth of their offspring; for I know their wickedness, all that they do here today before I bring them into the good land that I swore to their fathers.”

22 And Moses wrote this song on that day and taught it to the sons of Israel.

23 And Moses commanded Jesus and said to him, “Be manly and strong; for you shall bring the sons of Israel into the land that the Lord swore to them, and he himself shall be with you.”

24 And when Moses finished writing all the words of this law in a book to the end,

25 he commanded the Levites who carry the ark of the Lord’s covenant, saying,

26 “Take the book of this law and place it beside the ark of the covenant of the Lord your God, and it shall be there among you as a witness.

27 For I know your provocation and your stiff neck; for even while I am alive with you today, you have been embittering matters toward God; how much more after my death?

28 Gather to me your tribal leaders and your elders and your judges and your scribal instructors, so that I may speak all these words into their ears and call heaven and earth to witness to them;

29 for I know that after my death you shall surely act lawlessly and turn aside from the way that I commanded you, and evils shall meet you at the end of days, because you shall do what is evil before the Lord, provoking him to anger by the works of your hands.”

30 And Moses spoke into the ears of all the assembly of Israel the words of this song to the end.

Chapter 32

1 Attend, heaven, and I shall speak, and let earth hear words from my mouth.

2 Let my utterance be awaited as rain, and let my words come down as dew, like a shower upon grass and like snow upon herbage.

3 For I called upon the name of the Lord; give greatness to our God.

4 God—his works are true, and all his ways are judgments; a faithful God, and there is no injustice; righteous and holy is the Lord.

5 Blemished children sinned, not against him, a crooked and twisted generation.

6 Do you repay the Lord thus, foolish and unwise people? Is he not your father who acquired you and made you and created you?

7 Remember days of old, understand years of generation after generations; ask your father, and he shall tell you, your elders, and they shall say to you.

8 When the Most High divided nations, when he scattered the sons of Adam, he set the boundaries of nations according to the number of angels of God,

9 and the Lord’s portion became his people Jacob, the measured allotment of his inheritance Israel.

10 He provided for him in a wilderness land, in a thirst of heat in a waterless place; he encircled him and instructed him and guarded him as the pupil of an eye,

11 as an eagle might shelter its nest and yearned over its young; spreading its wings it received them and took them up on its back.

12 The Lord alone led them, and no foreign god was with them.

13 He brought them up upon the strength of the land, fed them produce of fields; they suckled honey from a rock and oil from a solid rock,

14 butter of cattle and milk of sheep with fat of lambs and rams, sons of bulls and goats, with fat of kidneys of wheat; and they drank wine, blood of the grape.

15 And Jacob ate and was filled, and the beloved one kicked; he grew fat, grew heavy, grew broad; and he forsook God who made him and departed from God his savior.

16 They provoked me with foreign things; with their abominations they made me bitter;

17 they sacrificed to demons and not to God, to gods whom they did not know; new ones, recently arrived, whom their fathers did not know.

18 You forsook God who begot you and forgot God who nourished you.

19 And the Lord saw and was jealous and was provoked by the anger of his sons and daughters,

20 and said, “I shall turn my face away from them and show what shall befall them at the end; for they are a perverse generation, sons in whom there is no faith.”

21 They made me jealous over what is no god; they provoked me to anger with their idols; and I shall make them jealous over what is no nation; over an uncomprehending nation I shall provoke them to anger.

22 For fire has been kindled from my fury; it shall burn down to Hades below, devour the land and its produce, and burn the foundations of mountains.

23 I shall gather evils against them and spend my arrows on them.

24 Melting with famine and the eating of birds and incurable backward-stiffening; I shall send the teeth of beasts against them, with the fury of things crawling upon the ground.

25 Outside, a sword shall make them childless, and from the storerooms, fear; young man with virgin, nursing child with a settled elder.

26 I said, ‘I shall scatter them; I shall put an end to their remembrance among people,’

27 if not for the anger of enemies, so that they might not last long and so that the adversaries might not join together, lest they say, ‘Our hand is high, and it was not the Lord who did all these things.’

28 For they are a nation that has lost counsel, and there is no knowledge in them.

29 They did not think to understand these things; let them receive them for the time to come.

30 How shall one pursue a thousand and two dislodge myriads, unless God sold them and the Lord handed them over?

31 For their gods are not as our God; but our enemies are senseless.

32 For their vine is from the vine of Sodom, and their branch from Gomorra; their grape is a grape of gall, a cluster of bitterness for them;

33 their wine is the fury of dragons and the incurable fury of asps.

34 Are not these things gathered with me and sealed in my treasuries?

35 On a day of vengeance I shall repay, at a time when their foot slips; for the day of their destruction is near, and things are ready for you.

36 For the Lord shall judge his people, and concerning his servants he shall be comforted; for he saw them paralyzed and exhausted under assault and laid low.

37 And the Lord said, ‘Where are their gods in whom they trusted,

38 whose sacrifices’ fat you ate and whose libations’ wine you drank? Let them rise and help you, and let them become shelters for you.

39 See, see that I am, and there is no god besides me; I shall kill and make alive, I shall strike and I shall heal, and there is no one who shall rescue from my hands.

40 For I shall raise my hand to heaven and swear by my right hand and say, “I live forever,

41 for I shall sharpen my sword like lightning, and my hand shall take hold of judgment, and I shall repay justice to enemies and repay those who hate me;

42 I shall make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword shall devour flesh, from the blood of the wounded and of captivity, from the head of rulers of enemies.

43 Rejoice, heavens, with him, and let all sons of God bow down to him; rejoice, nations, with his people, and let all angels of God strengthen him; for he avenges the blood of his sons, and he shall avenge and repay justice to enemies and repay those who hate him, and the Lord shall cleanse the land of his people.”

44 And Moses wrote this song on that day and taught it to the sons of Israel. And Moses entered and spoke all the words of this law into the ears of the people, he and Jesus son of Naue.

45 And Moses finished speaking to all Israel

46 and said to them, “Attend with your heart to all these words that I testify to you today, which you shall command your sons to guard and do, all the words of this law;

47 for this is not an empty word for you, because this is your life, and because of this word you shall live long upon the land into which you are crossing the Jordan to inherit it.”

48 And the Lord spoke to Moses on this day, saying,

49 “Go up to this mountain of Abarin, Mount Nabau, which is in the land of Moab opposite Jericho, and see the land of Canaan that I give the sons of Israel for a possession,

50 and die on the mountain to which you go up and be added to your people, as Aaron your brother died on Mount Or and was added to his people,

51 because you disobeyed my word among the sons of Israel at the water of dispute of Kades in the wilderness of Sin, because you did not sanctify me among the sons of Israel;

52 for you shall see the land from opposite it, but you shall not enter there.”

Chapter 33

1 And this is the blessing with which Moses, the man of God, blessed the sons of Israel before his death;

2 and he said, “The Lord has come from Sina and appeared from Seir to us and hastened from Mount Pharan with myriads of Kades; at his right hand angels were with him.

3 And he spared his people, and all the sanctified ones are under your hands; and these are under you, and he received from his words

4 a law that Moses commanded us, an inheritance for the assemblies of Jacob.

5 And there shall be a ruler among the beloved one, when rulers of peoples are gathered together with the tribes of Israel.

6 Let Reuben live and not die, and let him be many in number.

7 And this is for Judas: ‘Hear, Lord, the voice of Judas, and may they come into his people; his hands shall decide for him, and you shall be a helper against his enemies.’

8 And to Levi he said, ‘Give Levi his manifest things and his truth to the holy man whom they tested in a trial and reviled at the water of dispute;

9 the one who says to his father and mother, “I have not seen you,” and did not acknowledge his brothers and disowned his sons; he guarded your oracles and kept your covenant.

10 They shall make your ordinances known to Jacob and your law to Israel; they shall put incense in your anger continually upon your altar.

11 Bless, Lord, his strength, and receive the works of his hands; break the loins of enemies rising against him, and let those who hate him not rise.’

12 And to Benjamin he said, ‘Beloved by the Lord, he shall dwell in trust, and God shades him all the days, and between his shoulders he rested.’

13 And to Joseph he said, ‘From the blessing of the Lord is his land, from the seasons of heaven and dew and from the deep springs below

14 and according to the season of the produce of the sun’s turnings and from the conjunctions of months

15 and from the summit of mountains of the beginning and from the summit of everlasting hills

16 and according to the season of the earth’s fullness. And may the things acceptable to the one who appeared in the bush come upon Joseph’s head, and upon the crown of the one glorified among brothers.

17 His beauty is a bull’s firstborn; his horns are horns of a one-horned beast; with them he shall gore nations together to the end of the earth. These are Ephraim’s myriads, and these are Manasse’s thousands.’

18 And to Zabulon he said, ‘Rejoice, Zabulon, in your going out, and Issachar in his dwellings.

19 They shall destroy nations, and you shall call upon there and sacrifice a sacrifice of righteousness, because the wealth of the sea shall suckle you and the trade of those dwelling by the sea.’

20 And to Gad he said, ‘Blessed is the one who broadens Gad; like a lion he rested, having broken arm and ruler.

21 And he saw his first fruits, because there a land of rulers was allotted, assembled together with leaders of peoples; the Lord did righteousness and his judgment with Israel.’

22 And to Dan he said, ‘Dan is a lion’s cub and shall leap out from Basan.’

23 And to Nephthali he said, ‘Nephthali is a fullness of acceptable things, and let him be filled with blessing from the Lord; he shall inherit sea and south.’

24 And to Aser he said, ‘Blessed among children is Aser, and he shall be acceptable to his brothers; he shall dip his foot in oil;

25 iron and bronze shall be his sandal, and as your days, so your strength.

26 There is none like the God of the beloved one, who rides upon heaven as your helper, and the majestic one of the firmament.

27 And the covering of God is of the beginning and beneath the strength of everlasting arms; and he shall cast out the enemy from before your face, saying, “Perish.”

28 And Israel shall dwell alone in trust upon the land of Jacob, upon grain and wine, and the heaven for him is clouded with dew.

29 Blessed are you, Israel; who is like you, a people saved by the Lord? Your helper shall shield you, and the sword is your boast; and your enemies shall lie to you, and you shall tread upon their necks.’

Chapter 34

1 And Moses went up from Araboth Moab to Mount Nabau, to the summit of Phasga, which is opposite Jericho, and the Lord showed him all the land of Galaad as far as Dan

2 and all the land of Nephthali and all the land of Ephraim and Manasse and all the land of Judas as far as the farthest sea

3 and the wilderness and the regions around Jericho, the city of palms, as far as Segor.

4 And the Lord said to Moses, “This is the land that I swore to Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, saying, ‘I shall give it to your offspring’; and I have shown it to your eyes, but you shall not enter there.”

5 And Moses, household servant of the Lord, died in the land of Moab by the word of the Lord.

6 And they buried him in Gai in the land of Moab near the house of Phogor; and no one knows his burial place to this day.

7 And Moses was one hundred and twenty years old when he died; his eyes were not dimmed, nor were his chelynia worn out.

8 And the sons of Israel wept for Moses in Araboth Moab by the Jordan opposite Jericho for thirty days; and the days of mourning and weeping for Moses were completed.

9 And Jesus son of Naue was filled with a spirit of understanding, for Moses had laid his hands upon him; and the sons of Israel listened to him and did as the Lord commanded Moses.

10 And no prophet arose again in Israel like Moses, whom the Lord knew face to face,

11 in all the signs and wonders that the Lord sent him to do in the land of Egypt before Pharaoh and his attendants and all his land,

12 the great marvels and the mighty hand that Moses performed before all Israel.

Joshua

Chapter 1

1 And it happened after the death of Moses that the Lord spoke to Jesus son of Naue, the assistant of Moses, saying,

2 “Moses my attendant has died; now therefore rise and cross the Jordan, you and all this people, into the land that I give them.

3 Every place upon which you set the sole of your feet I shall give to you, as I said to Moses;

4 the wilderness and Antilibanos as far as the great river, the river Euphrates, and as far as the farthest sea from the setting of the sun shall be your boundaries.

5 No person shall stand against you all the days of your life, and as I was with Moses, so I shall be with you, and I shall not forsake you nor overlook you.

6 Be strong and manly; for you shall allot to this people the land that I swore to your fathers to give them.

7 Therefore be strong and manly, to guard and do as Moses my servant commanded you, and you shall not turn aside from them to right or left, so that you may understand in all that you do.

8 And the book of this law shall not depart from your mouth, and you shall meditate on it day and night, so that you may understand to do all that is written; then you shall prosper and make your ways prosper, and then you shall understand.

9 Behold, I have commanded you; be strong and manly, do not be cowardly nor afraid, because the Lord your God is with you in every place wherever you go.”

10 And Jesus commanded the scribes of the people, saying,

11 “Go through the midst of the people’s camp and command the people, saying, ‘Prepare provisions, because in yet three days you are crossing this Jordan to enter and take possession of the land that the Lord, the God of your fathers, gives you.’”

12 And to Reuben and Gad and the half tribe of Manasse Jesus said,

13 “Remember the word of the Lord that Moses, the servant of the Lord, commanded you, saying, ‘The Lord your God has given you rest and has given you this land.

14 Let your wives and your children and your animals dwell in the land that he gave you; but you shall cross over lightly equipped ahead of your brothers, every strong man, and fight alongside them,

15 until the Lord your God gives your brothers rest as he did you, and they too inherit the land that the Lord our God gives them; and each of you shall go away to his inheritance that Moses gave you beyond the Jordan toward the rising of the sun.’”

16 And answering Jesus they said, “Everything you command us we shall do, and to every place wherever you send us we shall go;

17 in every way that we listened to Moses, we shall listen to you, only may the Lord our God be with you as he was with Moses.

18 And the person who disobeys you and does not listen to your words, as you command him, let him die. But be strong and manly.”

Chapter 2

1 And Jesus son of Naue sent two young men from Sattin to spy, saying, “Go up and see the land and Jericho.” And the two young men went and entered Jericho and entered the house of a prostitute woman named Raab and lodged there.

2 And it was reported to the king of Jericho, saying, “Men of the sons of Israel have come in here to spy out the land.”

3 And the king of Jericho sent and said to Raab, saying, “Bring out the men who entered your house in the night; for they have come to spy out the land.”

4 And the woman took the men and hid them and said to them, “The men have come to me;

5 but when the gate was being shut in the darkness, the men went out; I do not know where they have gone. Pursue after them, if you can overtake them.”

6 But she had brought them up onto the roof and hidden them among the stalks of flax that she had piled on the roof.

7 And the men pursued after them on the road to the Jordan, toward the crossings, and the gate was shut. And it happened when those pursuing them had gone out

8 and before they themselves went to sleep, she went up onto the roof to them

9 and said to them, “I know that the Lord has given you the land, for fear of you has fallen upon us;

10 for we have heard that the Lord God dried up the Red Sea before your face when you went out from the land of Egypt, and what he did to the two kings of the Amorites beyond the Jordan, Seon and Og, whom you destroyed;

11 and when we heard, we were beside ourselves in our hearts, and no spirit remained in any of us before your face, because the Lord your God is God in heaven above and on the earth below.

12 And now swear to me by the Lord God that, as I show you mercy, you too shall show mercy to my father’s house

13 and preserve alive my father’s house and my mother and my brothers and all my household and all that belongs to them, and you shall deliver my life from death.”

14 And the men said to her, “Our life in place of yours unto death.” And she said, “When the Lord hands the city over to you, you shall show me mercy and truth.”

15 And she lowered them through the window

16 and said to them, “Go away to the hill country, lest those pursuing meet you, and hide there for three days until those pursuing you turn back; and after that you shall go on your way.”

17 And the men said to her, “We are innocent of this oath of yours;

18 behold, we are entering a part of the city, and you shall set the sign: you shall tie this red cord in the window through which you lowered us, and you shall gather your father and your mother and your brothers and all your father’s household to yourself into your house.

19 And it shall be that everyone who goes out the door of your house outside shall be liable for himself, but we shall be innocent of this oath of yours; and all who are with you in your house, we shall be liable.

20 But if anyone wrongs us or reveals these words of ours, we shall be innocent of this oath of yours.”

21 And she said to them, “According to your word, so let it be”; and she sent them away.

22 And they went and came to the hill country and remained there three days; and those pursuing searched all the roads and did not find them.

23 And the two young men returned and came down from the mountain and crossed over to Jesus son of Naue and related to him everything that had happened to them.

24 And they said to Jesus, “The Lord has handed over all the land into our hand, and everyone dwelling in that land has cowered before us.”

Chapter 3

1 And Jesus rose early in the morning, and they set out from Sattin and came as far as the Jordan and lodged there before crossing.

2 And it happened after three days that the scribes passed through the camp

3 and commanded the people, saying, “When you see the ark of the covenant of the Lord our God and our priests and the Levites carrying it, set out from your places and go behind it;

4 but let there be a distance between you and it of about two thousand cubits; you shall stand, not come near it, so that you may know the way you go; for you have not gone this way yesterday or the day before.”

5 And Jesus said to the people, “Purify yourselves for tomorrow, because tomorrow the Lord shall do wonders among you.”

6 And Jesus said to the priests, “Take up the ark of the Lord’s covenant and go before the people.” And the priests took up the ark of the Lord’s covenant and went before the people.

7 And the Lord said to Jesus, “On this day I begin to exalt you before all the sons of Israel, so that they may know that as I was with Moses, so I shall be with you.

8 And now command the priests who carry the ark of the covenant, saying, ‘When you enter the edge of the water of the Jordan, you shall stand in the Jordan.’”

9 And Jesus said to the sons of Israel, “Come here and hear the word of the Lord our God.

10 By this you shall know that the living God is among you and that he shall surely destroy from before our face the Canaanite and the Chettite and the Pherezite and the Euaite and the Amorite and the Gergesite and the Jebusite;

11 behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth crosses the Jordan.

12 Choose for yourselves twelve men from the sons of Israel, one from each tribe.

13 And it shall be that when the feet of the priests carrying the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth rest in the water of the Jordan, the water of the Jordan shall fail, but the water coming down shall stand.”

14 And the people set out from their dwellings to cross the Jordan, and the priests carried the ark of the Lord’s covenant ahead of the people.

15 And when the priests carrying the ark of the covenant entered the Jordan and the feet of the priests carrying the ark of the Lord’s covenant were dipped into the edge of the Jordan’s water—the Jordan filled all along its bank as in the days of wheat harvest—,

16 the waters coming down from above stood; they stood in one mass very far away as far as the region of Kariathiarim, but what was coming down went down into the sea of Araba, the Salt Sea, until it failed completely; and the people stood opposite Jericho.

17 And the priests carrying the ark of the Lord’s covenant stood on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan; and all the sons of Israel crossed on dry ground until all the people had finished crossing the Jordan.

Chapter 4

1 And when all the people had finished crossing the Jordan, the Lord said to Jesus, saying,

2 “Take men from the people, one from each tribe,

3 and instruct them, saying, ‘Take up twelve prepared stones from the middle of the Jordan and carry them with yourselves and put them in your camp wherever you camp tonight.’”

4 And Jesus called twelve men of distinction from the sons of Israel, one from each tribe,

5 and said to them, “Come forward before me, before the Lord, into the middle of the Jordan, and let each take up a stone from there and carry it on his shoulders according to the number of the twelve tribes of Israel,

6 so that these may be a sign for you, set down always, so that when your son asks you tomorrow, saying, ‘What are these stones to you?’

7 you shall explain to your son, saying, ‘The river Jordan failed before the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth as it crossed it’; and these stones shall be a memorial for you, for the sons of Israel, forever.”

8 And the sons of Israel did thus as the Lord commanded Jesus, and took twelve stones from the middle of the Jordan, as the Lord instructed Jesus at the completion of the sons of Israel’s crossing, and carried them with themselves into the camp and laid them there.

9 And Jesus also set up twelve other stones in the Jordan itself at the place beneath the feet of the priests who carried the ark of the Lord’s covenant, and they are there to this day.

10 And the priests who carried the ark of the covenant stood in the Jordan until Jesus had finished everything that the Lord commanded him to tell the people, and the people hurried and crossed.

11 And it happened when all the people had finished crossing that the ark of the Lord’s covenant crossed, and the stones before them.

12 And the sons of Reuben and the sons of Gad and the half of the tribe of Manasse crossed equipped before the sons of Israel, as Moses commanded them.

13 Forty thousand lightly equipped for battle crossed before the Lord for war toward the city of Jericho.

14 On that day the Lord exalted Jesus before all the race of Israel, and they feared him as they did Moses as long as he lived.

15 And the Lord said to Jesus, saying,

16 “Command the priests who carry the ark of the covenant of the Lord’s testimony to come up out of the Jordan.”

17 And Jesus commanded the priests, saying, “Come up out of the Jordan.”

18 And it happened when the priests carrying the ark of the Lord’s covenant had come up out of the Jordan and set their feet upon the land, the water of the Jordan rushed back to its place and flowed as yesterday and the day before along all its bank.

19 And the people came up out of the Jordan on the tenth of the first month; and the sons of Israel camped in Galgalois in the part toward the sunrise from Jericho.

20 And these twelve stones that he took from the Jordan Jesus set up in Galgalois,

21 saying, “When your sons ask you, saying, ‘What are these stones?’

22 tell your sons that Israel crossed the Jordan on dry ground,

23 the Lord our God having dried up the water of the Jordan before them until they crossed, just as the Lord our God did to the Red Sea, which the Lord our God dried up before us until we passed through,

24 so that all the nations of the earth may know that the power of the Lord is strong and that you may revere the Lord your God at all times.”

Chapter 5

1 And it happened when the kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan and the kings of Phoenicia by the sea heard that the Lord God had dried up the river Jordan before the sons of Israel as they crossed, their minds melted and they were astonished, and no understanding at all remained in them before the sons of Israel.

2 At that time the Lord said to Jesus, “Make for yourself stone knives from a sharp-edged stone and, sitting down, circumcise the sons of Israel.”

3 And Jesus made sharp-edged stone knives and circumcised the sons of Israel at the place called Hill of the Foreskins.

4 And in the manner in which Jesus purified the sons of Israel, however many had been born on the way and however many of those who had gone out from Egypt were uncircumcised,

5 Jesus circumcised all these;

6 for Israel had spent forty-two years in the Madbarite wilderness, and for this reason most of them, the fighting men who had gone out from the land of Egypt and had disobeyed God’s commandments, were uncircumcised; to these he also determined that they would not see the land that the Lord swore to their fathers to give us, a land flowing with milk and honey.

7 And in place of these he raised up their sons, whom Jesus circumcised because they had been born uncircumcised along the way.

8 And having been circumcised, they rested there, sitting in the camp until they were healed.

9 And the Lord said to Jesus son of Naue, “On this very day I have removed the reproach of Egypt from you.” And he called the name of that place Galgala.

10 And the sons of Israel observed the Passover on the fourteenth day of the month from evening, west of Jericho beyond the Jordan in the plain,

11 and they ate from the grain of the land, unleavened things and new things, on this day.

12 The manna ceased after they had eaten from the grain of the land, and manna was no longer available to the sons of Israel; but they partook of the region of the Phoenicians in that year.

13 And it happened when Jesus was in Jericho that he looked up with his eyes and saw a man standing before him, and a drawn sword was in his hand. And Jesus came forward and said to him, “Are you ours or one of our adversaries?”

14 And he said to him, “I have now arrived as commander-in-chief of the Lord’s force.” And Jesus fell face down to the ground and said to him, “Master, what do you command your household servant?”

15 And the commander-in-chief of the Lord says to Jesus, “Loosen the sandal from your feet; for the place upon which you stand is holy.”

Chapter 6

1 And Jericho was shut up and fortified, and no one went out of it or went in.

2 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Behold, I hand over Jericho under your hand, and its king and the strong ones in it who are mighty in strength;

3 but you shall station the fighting men around it,

5 and it shall be that when you sound the trumpet, let all the people shout together, and when they shout, the walls of the city shall fall of themselves, and all the people shall enter, each rushing straight ahead into the city.”

6 And Jesus son of Naue went in to the priests

7 and said to them, “Command the people to go around and encircle the city, and let the fighting men pass armed before the Lord;

8 and let seven priests having seven sacred trumpets likewise pass before the Lord and sound them strongly, and let the ark of the Lord’s covenant follow;

9 and let the fighting men pass in front, and the priests bringing up the rear go behind the ark of the Lord’s covenant, walking and sounding the trumpets.”

10 And Jesus commanded the people, saying, “Do not shout, nor let any of you hear the voice, until the day he announces to shout; then you shall shout.”

11 And the ark of God’s covenant, having gone around the city, immediately went away to the camp and slept there.

12 And on the second day Jesus arose early in the morning, and the priests took up the ark of the Lord’s covenant,

13 and the seven priests carrying the seven trumpets went ahead before the Lord, and after them the fighting men came in and the rest of the crowd behind the ark of the Lord’s covenant; and the priests sounded the trumpets, and all the rest of the crowd encircled the city nearby

14 and went away again to the camp. Thus he did for six days.

15 And on the seventh day they rose at dawn and went around the city six times;

16 and on the seventh circuit the priests sounded the trumpets, and Jesus said to the sons of Israel, “Shout; for the Lord has handed the city over to you.

17 And the city shall be devoted, it and everything in it, to the Lord Sabaoth; except Raab the prostitute, preserve her and all who are in her house.

18 But you, guard yourselves very carefully from the devoted thing, lest, considering it, you yourselves take from the devoted thing and make the camp of the sons of Israel devoted and wear us away;

19 and all silver or gold or bronze or iron shall be holy to the Lord; it shall be brought into the Lord’s treasury.”

20 And the priests sounded the trumpets; and when the people heard the sound of the trumpets, all the people together shouted with a great and strong shout. And the whole wall fell all around, and all the people went up into the city.

21 And Jesus devoted it and everything that was in the city, from man to woman, from young man to elder and to calf and beast of burden, by the edge of the sword.

22 And Jesus said to the two young men who had spied, “Enter the woman’s house and bring her out from there and everything that belongs to her.”

23 And the two young men who had spied out the city entered the woman’s house and brought out Raab the prostitute and her father and her mother and her brothers and everything that belonged to her and all her kin, and set her outside Israel’s camp.

24 And the city was burned with fire with everything in it, except that silver and gold and bronze and iron they gave to be brought into the Lord’s treasury.

25 And Jesus kept Raab the prostitute and all her father’s household alive, and she dwelt in Israel until this day, because she hid the spies whom Jesus sent to spy out Jericho. –

26 And Jesus made an oath on that day before the Lord, saying, “Accursed is the man who builds that city; with his firstborn he shall lay its foundation, and with his youngest he shall set up its gates.” And Ozan from Baethel did so; with Abiron his firstborn he founded it, and with his youngest, who survived, he set up its gates.

27 And the Lord was with Jesus, and his name was throughout all the land.

Chapter 7

1 And the sons of Israel committed a great trespass and appropriated from the devoted thing; and Achar son of Charmi son of Zambri son of Zara from the tribe of Judas took from the devoted thing; and the Lord was fiercely angered with the sons of Israel.

2 And Jesus sent men to Gai, which is by Baethel, saying, “Spy out Gai”; and the men went up and spied out Gai.

3 And they returned to Jesus and said to him, “Do not let all the people go up; let about two or three thousand men go up and besiege the city; do not bring all the people there, for they are few.”

4 And about three thousand men went up and fled before the men of Gai.

5 And the men of Gai killed about thirty-six men of them and pursued them from the gate and crushed them on the slope; and the people’s heart was terrified and became like water.

6 And Jesus tore his garments, and Jesus fell on the ground on his face before the Lord until evening, he and the elders of Israel, and they put earth on their heads.

7 And Jesus said, “I pray, Lord, why did your servant bring this people across the Jordan to hand them over to the Amorite to destroy us? If only we had remained and dwelt beside the Jordan.

8 And what shall I say, since Israel has turned the neck before its enemy?

9 And when the Canaanite and all the inhabitants of the land hear, they shall surround us and wear us away from the land; and what shall you do for your great name?”

10 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Arise; why have you fallen on your face like this?

11 The people have sinned and transgressed the covenant that I made with them, and, having stolen from the devoted thing, put it among their vessels.

12 The sons of Israel shall certainly not be able to stand before their enemies; they shall turn their neck before their enemies, because they have become devoted; I shall no longer continue to be with you unless you remove the devoted thing from among yourselves.

13 Rise, sanctify the people and tell them to be sanctified for tomorrow; thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: ‘The devoted thing is among you; you shall not be able to stand before your enemies until you remove the devoted thing from among you.’

14 And you shall all be gathered in the morning by tribes, and the tribe that the Lord shows you shall bring forward by clans; and the clan that the Lord shows you shall bring forward by household; and the household that the Lord shows you shall bring forward man by man;

15 and whoever is indicated shall be burned with fire, he and everything that belongs to him, because he transgressed the Lord’s covenant and committed lawlessness in Israel.” –

16 And Jesus rose early and brought forward the people by tribes, and the tribe of Judas was indicated;

17 and it was brought forward by clans, and the clan of Zara was indicated; and it was brought forward man by man,

18 and Achar son of Zambri son of Zara was indicated.

19 And Jesus said to Achar, “Give glory today to the Lord God of Israel and give the confession and tell me what you have done; do not hide it from me.”

20 And Achar answered Jesus and said, “Truly I sinned before the Lord God of Israel; thus and thus I did;

21 I saw among the spoil a fine, variegated, beautiful thing, and two hundred didrachmas of silver and one golden tongue of fifty didrachmas, and having thought about them I took them, and behold, they are hidden in the earth in my tent, and the silver is hidden beneath them.”

22 And Jesus sent messengers, and they ran to the tent in the camp; and these things were hidden in the tent, and the silver beneath them.

23 And they brought them out of the tent and brought them to Jesus and the elders of Israel, and set them before the Lord.

24 And Jesus took Achar son of Zara and brought him into the ravine of Achor, and his sons and his daughters and his calves and his beasts of burden and all his sheep and his tent and everything that belonged to him, and all the people with him; and he brought them into Emekachor.

25 And Jesus said to Achar, “Why did you destroy us? May the Lord destroy you, as today.” And all Israel stoned him with stones.

26 And they raised a great heap of stones over him. And the Lord ceased from the fury of his anger. Therefore he named it Emekachor to this day.

Chapter 8

1 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Do not fear nor be cowardly; take with you all the fighting men and rise and go up to Gai; behold, I have given into your hands the king of Gai and his land.

2 And you shall do to Gai as you did to Jericho and its king, and you shall take the spoil of the animals for yourself. But set an ambush for yourself behind the city.”

3 And Jesus and all the fighting people arose to go up to Gai. And Jesus chose thirty thousand men strong in might and sent them by night.

4 And he commanded them, saying, “You shall lie in ambush behind the city; do not be far from the city, and all of you shall be ready.

5 And I and all those with me shall approach the city, and it shall be that when the inhabitants of Gai come out to meet us as before, we shall flee before them.

6 And when they come out after us, we shall draw them away from the city; and they shall say, ‘These flee before us as they did before.’

7 But you shall rise up from the ambush and go into the city.

8 You shall do according to this word; behold, I have commanded you.”

9 And Jesus sent them, and they went to the ambush and lay between Baethel and Gai, to the west of Gai.

10 And Jesus rose early in the morning and inspected the people; and he and the elders went up before the people toward Gai.

11 And all the fighting people with him went up and, proceeding, came opposite the city from the east,

12 and the city’s ambush was from the west.

14 And it happened when the king of Gai saw, he hastened and went out to meet them directly for battle, he and all the people with him; and he did not know that there was an ambush for him behind the city.

15 And Jesus and Israel saw and withdrew before them.

16 And they pursued after the sons of Israel, and they themselves moved away from the city;

17 no one was left in Gai who did not pursue after Israel; and they left the city open and pursued after Israel.

18 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Stretch out your hand with the javelin in your hand toward the city—for I have handed it into your hands—and the ambush shall rise quickly from its place.” And Jesus stretched out his hand, the javelin, toward the city,

19 and the ambush rose quickly from its place and went out when he stretched out his hand, and they came upon the city and seized it and hurried to burn the city with fire.

20 And the inhabitants of Gai looked behind them and saw smoke rising from the city to heaven; and they no longer had anywhere to flee, here or there.

21 And Jesus and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city and that the smoke of the city had risen to heaven, and they turned and struck the men of Gai.

22 And these came out from the city to meet them, and they were between the camp, these on this side and those on that side; and they struck them until none of them remained saved or escaped.

23 And they seized the king of Gai alive and brought him to Jesus.

24 And when the sons of Israel finished killing all those of Gai in the plains and on the mountain on the descent, where they pursued them from it to the end, Jesus turned back to Gai and struck it with the edge of the sword.

25 And those who fell that day, from man to woman, were twelve thousand, all the inhabitants of Gai,

27 except for the animals and the spoils in the city, all that the sons of Israel took as spoil according to the Lord’s command, as the Lord instructed Jesus.

28 And Jesus burned the city with fire; he made it an uninhabited mound forever, until this day.

29 And he hung the king of Gai on a double tree, and he was on the tree until evening; and when the sun was setting, Jesus gave an order, and they took his body down from the tree and threw him into the pit and set a heap of stones over him until this day.

Chapter 9

1 And when the kings of the Amorites beyond the Jordan, those in the hill country and those in the plain and those along the whole shore of the Great Sea and those near Antilibanos, and the Chettites and the Canaanites and the Pherezites and the Euaites and the Amorites and the Gergesites and the Jebusites heard,

2 they all gathered together to wage war against Jesus and Israel together.

2 a Then Jesus built an altar to the Lord, the God of Israel, on Mount Gaibal,

3 as Moses the attendant of the Lord commanded the sons of Israel, as it is written in Moses’ law, an altar of whole stones upon which no iron had been laid, and there he offered whole burnt offerings to the Lord and a sacrifice of salvation.

4 And Jesus wrote upon the stones the second law, the law of Moses that he wrote before the sons of Israel.

5 And all Israel and their elders and their judges and their scribes passed on this side and that opposite the ark, and the priests and the Levites carried the ark of the Lord’s covenant, and the sojourner and the native-born, half of them near Mount Garizin and half of them near Mount Gaibal, as Moses the attendant of the Lord commanded, to bless the people first.

6 And after these things Jesus thus read all the words of this law, the blessings and the curses, according to all that is written in Moses’ law;

7 there was no word among all that Moses commanded Jesus that Jesus did not read into the ears of all the assembly of the sons of Israel, to the men and women and children and the sojourners who joined Israel.

3 And the inhabitants of Gabaon heard all that the Lord had done to Jericho and Gai.

4 And they too acted with cunning and, coming, provisioned themselves and prepared themselves and took old sacks on their donkeys and old, torn, tied-up wineskins,

5 and the hollow parts of their shoes and their sandals were old and resoled on their feet, and their garments worn out upon them, and their provision bread dry and moldy and eaten away.

6 And they came to Jesus in the camp of Israel at Galgala and said to Jesus and Israel, “We have come from a distant land, and now make a covenant with us.”

7 And the sons of Israel said to the Chorraite, “See that you are not dwelling among me; and how shall I make a covenant with you?”

8 And they said to Jesus, “We are your household servants.” And Jesus said to them, “Where are you from, and whence have you come?”

9 And they said, “Your servants have come from a very distant land in the name of the Lord your God; for we have heard his name and all that he did in Egypt

10 and all that he did to the kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, to Seon king of Esebon and Og king of Basan, who dwelt in Astaroth and Edraim.

11 And having heard, our elders and all the inhabitants of our land said to us, ‘Take provisions for yourselves for the journey and go to meet them and say to them, “We are your household servants, and now make a covenant with us.”’

12 These loaves we provisioned while hot on the day we went out to come to you, but now they have dried and become eaten away;

13 and these wineskins that we filled when new, these have torn; and our garments and our shoes have worn out from the very long journey.”

14 And the rulers took from their provisions and did not inquire of the Lord.

15 And Jesus made peace with them and made a covenant with them to preserve them, and the rulers of the assembly swore to them. –

16 And it happened three days after making a covenant with them that they heard that they were near them and dwelt among them.

17 And the sons of Israel set out and came to their cities; and their cities were Gabaon and Kephira and Beroth and the city of Iarin.

18 And the sons of Israel did not fight them, because all the rulers had sworn to them by the Lord, the God of Israel; and all the assembly murmured against the rulers.

19 And the rulers said to all the assembly, “We swore to them by the Lord, the God of Israel, and now we cannot touch them;

20 this we shall do: keep them alive, and we shall preserve them, and there shall be no anger against us because of the oath that we swore to them;

21 they shall live and be woodcutters and water carriers for all the assembly,” as the rulers said to them.

22 And Jesus called them together and said to them, “Why did you deceive me, saying, ‘We are very far from you,’ when you are local people among those dwelling with us?

23 And now you are accursed; a servant and a woodcutter for me and my God shall certainly not cease from among you.”

24 And they answered Jesus, saying, “We were told all that the Lord your God instructed Moses his servant, to give you this land and to destroy us and all who dwell upon it before your face, and we greatly feared for our lives before your face and did this thing.

25 And now behold, we are under your hands; do to us as pleases you and as seems good to you.”

26 And they did thus to them; and Jesus rescued them that day from the hands of the sons of Israel, and they did not kill them.

27 And Jesus appointed them on that day as woodcutters and water carriers for all the assembly and for the altar of God; for this reason the inhabitants of Gabaon became woodcutters and water carriers for the altar of God until this day and for the place that the Lord shall choose.

Chapter 10

1 And when Adonibezek king of Jerusalem heard that Jesus had taken Gai and destroyed it—as they did to Jericho and its king, so they did to Gai and its king—and that the inhabitants of Gabaon had gone over to Jesus and Israel,

2 they were very afraid among themselves; for he knew that Gabaon was a great city, like one of the chief cities, and all its men were strong.

3 And Adonibezek king of Jerusalem sent to Ailam king of Chebron and to Phidon king of Jerimuth and to Jephtha king of Lachis and to Dabir king of Odollam, saying,

4 “Come, go up to me and help me, and let us wage war against Gabaon; for they have gone over to Jesus and the sons of Israel.”

5 And the five kings of the Jebusites went up, the king of Jerusalem and the king of Chebron and the king of Jerimuth and the king of Lachis and the king of Odollam, they and all their people, and encamped around Gabaon and besieged it.

6 And the inhabitants of Gabaon sent to Jesus at Israel’s camp in Galgala, saying, “Do not relax your hands from your servants; come up to us quickly and deliver us and help us, for all the kings of the Amorites who dwell in the hill country are gathered against us.”

7 And Jesus went up from Galgala, he and all the fighting people with him, everyone strong in might.

8 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Do not fear them; for I have handed them into your hands; no one of them shall remain before you.”

9 And Jesus came upon them suddenly; he had traveled all night from Galgala.

10 And the Lord threw them into confusion before the sons of Israel, and the Lord crushed them with a great crushing in Gabaon, and they pursued them along the road of the ascent of Oronin and cut them down as far as Azeka and as far as Makeda.

11 And as they fled before the sons of Israel on the descent of Oronin, the Lord cast hailstones upon them from heaven as far as Azeka, and more died from the hailstones than the sons of Israel killed with the sword in battle.

12 Then Jesus spoke to the Lord on the day when God handed the Amorite under Israel’s hand, when he crushed them in Gabaon and they were crushed before the sons of Israel, and Jesus said, “Let the sun stand still over Gabaon and the moon over the ravine of Ailon.”

13 And the sun stood still and the moon stood in place until God defended them against their enemies. And the sun stood in the middle of heaven and did not go ahead toward setting for the end of one whole day.

14 And there was no such day before or afterward in which God listened to a person, because the Lord fought alongside Israel.

16 And these five kings fled and hid in the cave in Makeda.

17 And it was reported to Jesus, saying, “The five kings have been found hidden in the cave in Makeda.”

18 And Jesus said, “Roll stones over the mouth of the cave and appoint men to guard them,

19 but you must not stand still; pursue after your enemies and overtake their rear guard and do not let them enter their cities; for the Lord our God has handed them into our hands.”

20 And it happened when Jesus and all the sons of Israel finished striking them with a very great blow to the end, and those escaping escaped into the fortified cities,

21 all the people returned to Jesus at Makeda unharmed, and none of the sons of Israel made a sound with his tongue.

22 And Jesus said, “Open the cave and bring these five kings out of the cave.”

23 And they brought the five kings out of the cave: the king of Jerusalem and the king of Chebron and the king of Jerimuth and the king of Lachis and the king of Odollam.

24 And when they brought them to Jesus, Jesus called together all Israel and the leaders of the war who went with him, saying to them, “Come forward and put your feet upon their necks.” And they came forward and put their feet upon their necks.

25 And Jesus said to them, “Do not fear them or be cowardly; be manly and strong, because thus the Lord shall do to all your enemies against whom you wage war.”

26 And Jesus killed them and hung them on five trees, and they hung on the trees until evening.

27 And at sunset Jesus commanded, and they took them down from the trees and threw them into the cave into which they had fled, and rolled stones over the cave until this day.

28 And they took Makeda on that day and killed it with the edge of the sword and destroyed every breathing thing in it, and no one saved or escaped remained in it; and they did to the king of Makeda as they had done to the king of Jericho.

29 And Jesus and all Israel with him went from Makeda to Lebna and besieged Lebna.

30 And the Lord handed it into Israel’s hands, and they took it and its king and killed it with the edge of the sword and every breathing thing in it, and not even one saved or escaped remained in it; and they did to its king as they had done to the king of Jericho.

31 And Jesus and all Israel with him went from Lebna to Lachis and encamped around it and besieged it.

32 And the Lord handed Lachis into Israel’s hands, and he took it on the second day, and they killed it with the edge of the sword and destroyed it, as they had done to Lebna. –

33 Then Ailam king of Gazer went up to help Lachis, and Jesus struck him with the edge of the sword and his people, until none of them remained saved or escaped.

34 And Jesus and all Israel with him went from Lachis to Odollam and encamped around it and besieged it.

35 And the Lord handed it into Israel’s hand, and he took it on that day and killed it with the edge of the sword, and they killed every breathing thing in it, as they had done to Lachis.

36 And Jesus and all Israel with him went to Chebron and encamped around it.

37 And he struck it with the edge of the sword and every breathing thing in it; there was no survivor; as they had done to Odollam, they destroyed it and everything in it.

38 And Jesus and all Israel returned to Dabir and encamped around it,

39 and they took it and its king and its villages and struck it with the edge of the sword and destroyed it and every breathing thing in it and left no survivor in it; as they had done to Chebron and its king, so they did to Dabir and its king.

40 And Jesus struck all the land of the hill country and the Nageb and the plain and Asedoth and its kings; they left no survivor among them; and he destroyed every living, breathing thing, as the Lord, the God of Israel, had commanded,

41 from Kades Barne to Gaza, all Gosom as far as Gabaon,

42 and Jesus struck all their kings and their land at once, because the Lord, the God of Israel, fought alongside Israel.

Chapter 11

1 And when Jabin king of Asor heard, he sent to Jobab king of Marron and to the king of Symoon and to the king of Aziph

2 and to the kings by great Sidon, into the hill country and into Raba opposite Keneroth and into the plain and into Napheddor

3 and to the coastal Canaanites from the east and to the coastal Amorites and Euaites and Jebusites and Pherezites in the mountain and the Chettites below Aermon in the land of Massepha.

4 And they and their kings with them came out, like the sand of the sea in multitude, and very many horses and chariots.

5 And all these kings gathered and came together and encamped by the water of Marron to fight Israel.

6 And the Lord said to Jesus, “Do not fear before them, because tomorrow at this hour I shall hand them over routed before Israel; you shall cut the tendons of their horses and burn their chariots with fire.”

7 And Jesus and all the fighting people came upon them by the water of Marron suddenly and fell upon them in the hill country.

8 And the Lord handed them under Israel’s hand, and, striking them, they pursued as far as great Sidon and as far as Maserōn and as far as the plains of Massoch toward the east, and cut them down until none remained saved.

9 And Jesus did to them as the Lord commanded him; he cut the tendons of their horses and burned their chariots with fire.

10 And Jesus turned back at that time and seized Asor and its king; Asor had formerly ruled all these kingdoms.

11 And they killed every breathing thing in it with the sword and destroyed all, and no breathing thing remained in it; and they burned Asor with fire.

12 And Jesus took all the cities of the kings and their kings and killed them with the edge of the sword, and they destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the Lord instructed.

13 But Israel did not burn all the cities built upon mounds; Jesus burned Asor alone.

14 And the sons of Israel took all its spoils for themselves, but destroyed all of them with the edge of the sword until he had destroyed them; they left not one breathing thing among them.

15 As the Lord instructed Moses his servant, so Moses commanded Jesus, and thus Jesus did; he transgressed nothing of all that Moses instructed him.

16 And Jesus took all the hill country and all the Nageb and all the land of Gosom and the plain and the western region and the mountain of Israel and the lowlands,

17 the regions by the mountain from Mount Achel and what rises toward Seir and as far as Baalgad and the plains of Lebanon below Mount Aermon; and he took all their kings and killed them and put them to death.

18 And Jesus waged war against these kings for many days,

19 and there was no city that Israel did not take; they took all in war.

20 For it came about through the Lord that their heart was made strong to meet Israel in war, so that they would be destroyed, so that mercy would not be given them, but that they would be destroyed, as the Lord said to Moses.

21 And Jesus came at that time and destroyed the Enakim from the hill country, from Chebron and Dabir and Anaboth and from all the race of Israel and from all the mountain of Judas with their cities; and Jesus destroyed them.

22 None of the Enakim remained from the sons of Israel, except that some remained in Gaza and Geth and Asedoth.

23 And Jesus took all the land as the Lord commanded Moses, and Jesus gave them as an inheritance to Israel in divisions according to their tribes. And the land rested from being at war.

Chapter 12

1 And these are the kings of the land whom the sons of Israel killed and whose land they inherited beyond the Jordan toward the rising of the sun, from the ravine of Arnon as far as Mount Aermon and all the land of Araba to the east:

2 Seon king of the Amorites, who dwelt in Esebon and ruled from Aroer, which is in the ravine, along part of the ravine and half of Galaad as far as Jabok, the boundary of the sons of Ammon,

3 and Araba as far as the Sea of Chenereth to the east and as far as the Sea of Araba, the Sea of Salt, from the east, the road by Asimoth, from Thaiman below Asedoth Phasga;

4 and Og king of Basan, who was left of the giants, dwelling in Astaroth and Edraim,

5 ruling from Mount Aermon and from Selcha and all Basan as far as the boundaries of Gesuri and Machati and half of Galaad, the boundary of Seon king of Esebon.

6 Moses the servant of the Lord and the sons of Israel struck them, and Moses gave it as an inheritance to Reuben and Gad and the half tribe of Manasse.

7 And these are the kings of the Amorites whom Jesus and the sons of Israel killed beyond the Jordan by the sea, Baalgad in the plain of Lebanon and as far as Mount Chelcha on the ascent to Seir, and Jesus gave it to the tribes of Israel to inherit according to their allotment,

8 in the mountain and in the plain and in Araba and in Asedoth and in the wilderness and in Nageb: the Chettite and the Amorite and the Canaanite and the Pherezite and the Euaite and the Jebusite;

9 the king of Jericho and the king of Gai, which is near Baethel,

10 king of Jerusalem, king of Chebron,

11 king of Jerimuth, king of Lachis,

12 king of Ailam, king of Gazer,

13 king of Dabir, king of Gader,

14 king of Ermath, king of Arath,

15 king of Lebna, king of Odollam,

16 king of Makeda,

17 king of Taphoug, king of Opher,

18 king of Aphek of Saron,

19 king of Asor,

20 king of Symoon, king of Marron, king of Aziph,

21 king of Kades, king of Tanach,

22 king of Magedon, king of Jekonam of Chermel,

23 king of Dor of Napheddor, king of Goim of Galilee,

24 king of Tharsa; all these were twenty-nine kings.

Chapter 13

1 And Jesus was old, advanced in days. And the Lord said to Jesus, “You are advanced in days, and much land remains for an inheritance.

2 And this is the land left: the territories of the Philistines, the Gesirite and the Canaanite;

3 from the uninhabited region opposite Egypt to the boundaries of Akkaron, from the left of the Canaanites, it is reckoned to the five satrapies of the Philistines, to the Gazaite and the Azotite and the Ascalonite and the Getthite and the Akkaronite; and to the Euaite

4 from Thaiman and all the land of Canaan opposite Gaza, and the Sidonians as far as Aphek, as far as the boundaries of the Amorites,

5 and all the land of the Gabli Philistines and all Lebanon toward the sunrise from Galgal below Mount Aermon as far as the entrance of Emath;

6 every inhabitant of the hill country from Lebanon as far as Maserephothmaim, all the Sidonians, I shall destroy them from before Israel; but distribute it as an inheritance to Israel, as I commanded you.

7 And now divide this land as an inheritance to the nine tribes and the half tribe of Manasse; from the Jordan to the Great Sea toward the setting of the sun you shall give it; the Great Sea shall bound it.

8 But to the two tribes and the half tribe of Manasse, to Reuben and Gad, Moses gave beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise; Moses the servant of the Lord gave it

9 from Aroer, which is on the edge of the torrent Arnon, and the city in the middle of the ravine and all Misor from Maidaba to Daiban,

10 all the cities of Seon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Esebon, as far as the boundaries of the sons of Ammon

11 and the Galaadite region and the boundaries of Gesiri and Machati, all Mount Aermon and all the Basanite region as far as Selcha,

12 all the kingdom of Og in the Basanite region, who reigned in Astaroth and Edraim; he was left of the giants, and Moses struck him and destroyed him.

13 And the sons of Israel did not destroy the Gesirite and the Machatite and the Canaanite, and the king of Gesiri and the Machatite dwelt among the sons of Israel until this day.

14 Except to the tribe of Levi no inheritance was given; the Lord, the God of Israel, he is their inheritance, as the Lord said to them. And this is the division that Moses divided to the sons of Israel in Araboth Moab beyond the Jordan opposite Jericho.

15 And Moses gave to the tribe of Reuben according to their clans.

16 And their boundaries were from Aroer, which is opposite the ravine of Arnon, and the city in the ravine of Arnon and all Misor

17 as far as Esebon and all the cities in Misor, and Daibon and Bamothbaal and the house of Beelmon

18 and Jassa and Kedemoth and Mephaath

19 and Kariathaim and Sebama and Serada and Sior on Mount Emak

20 and Baethphogor and Asedoth Phasga and Baethasimoth

21 and all the cities of Misor and all the kingdom of Seon king of the Amorites, whom Moses struck, him and the leaders of Madian and Eui and Rokom and Sour and Our and Robe, rulers beside Seon and the inhabitants of the land.

22 And Balaam son of Beor, the seer, they killed in the turn.

23 And the boundary of Reuben was the Jordan as boundary. This is the inheritance of the sons of Reuben according to their clans, their cities and their settlements.

24 And Moses gave to the sons of Gad according to their clans.

25 And their boundaries were Jazer, all the cities of Galaad and half the land of the sons of Ammon as far as Aroer, which is opposite Rabba,

26 and from Esebon as far as Ramoth by Massepha and Botanin and Maanain as far as the boundaries of Dabir

27 and in Emek, Baetharam and Baethanabra and Sokchotha and Saphan and the rest of the kingdom of Seon king of Esebon, and the Jordan shall bound it as far as the region of the Sea of Chenereth beyond the Jordan to the east.

28 This is the inheritance of the sons of Gad according to their clans, their cities and their settlements.

29 And Moses gave to the half tribe of Manasse according to their clans.

30 And their boundaries were from Maanain and all the kingdom of Basani and all the kingdom of Og king of Basan and all the villages of Jair that are in the Basanite region, sixty cities,

31 and half of Galaad and in Astaroth and Edraim, cities of Og’s kingdom in the Basanite region; and they were given to the sons of Machir son of Manasse and to the half of the sons of Machir son of Manasse according to their clans.

32 These are those whom Moses made inherit beyond the Jordan in Araboth Moab beyond the Jordan opposite Jericho to the east.

Chapter 14

1 And these are those of the sons of Israel who inherited in the land of Canaan, to whom Eleazar the priest and Jesus son of Naue and the leaders of the families of the tribes of the sons of Israel allotted it.

2 By lots they inherited, as the Lord commanded by the hand of Jesus for the nine tribes and the half tribe,

3 from beyond the Jordan, and to the Levites he did not give an allotment among them;

4 because the sons of Joseph were two tribes, Manasse and Ephraim, and no portion in the land was given to the Levites except cities to dwell in and their set-apart areas for the animals and their animals.

5 As the Lord commanded Moses, so the sons of Israel did and divided the land.

6 And the sons of Judas came to Jesus in Galgal, and Chaleb son of Jephonne the Kenezite said to him, “You know the word that the Lord spoke to Moses, the man of God, concerning me and you in Kades Barne;

7 for I was forty years old when Moses the servant of God sent me from Kades Barne to spy out the land, and I answered him a word according to his mind,

8 but my brothers who went up with me shifted the people’s heart, whereas I attached myself to follow the Lord my God,

9 and Moses swore on that day, saying, ‘The land upon which you set foot shall be yours as an inheritance and your children’s forever, because you attached yourself to follow after the Lord our God.’

10 And now the Lord has sustained me, as he said, this forty-fifth year since the Lord spoke this word to Moses and Israel walked in the wilderness. And now behold, I am eighty-five years old today;

11 I am still strong today as when Moses sent me; likewise I am strong now to go out and enter into war.

12 And now I ask you for this mountain, as the Lord said on that day; for you heard this word on that day. But now the Enakim are there, fortified and great cities; if then the Lord is with me, I shall destroy them, as the Lord said to me.”

13 And Jesus blessed him and gave Chebron to Chaleb son of Jephonne son of Kenez as an inheritance.

14 For this reason Chebron became the inheritance of Chaleb son of Jephonne the Kenezite until this day because he followed the command of the Lord, the God of Israel.

15 And the name of Chebron formerly was City of Arbok; this was a chief city of the Enakim. And the land ceased from war.

Chapter 15

1 And the boundaries of the tribe of Judas according to their clans were from the boundaries of Idumaea, from the wilderness of Sin as far as Kades toward the south.

2 And their boundaries were from the south as far as the region of the Salt Sea, from the ridge that runs toward the south,

3 and it goes across opposite the ascent of Akrabin and circles Senna and ascends from the south to Kades Barne and goes out to Asoron and ascends to Addara and goes around the western side of Kades

4 and goes to Asemona and passes as far as the ravine of Egypt, and its boundary shall have its outlet at the sea; these are their boundaries from the south.

5 And the boundaries from the east: the whole Salt Sea as far as the Jordan. And their boundaries from the north, from the ridge of the sea and from the region of the Jordan:

6 the boundary goes up to Baethagla and passes on the north to Baetharaba, and the boundary ascends to the stone of Baion son of Reuben,

7 and the boundary ascends to the fourth part of the ravine of Achor and descends to Galgal, which is opposite the approach of Addamin, which is to the south of the ravine, and passes to the water of the Spring of the Sun, and its outlet shall be the spring Rogel,

8 and the boundary ascends to the ravine of Onom on the back of Jebus from the south [this is Jerusalem], and the boundary passes to the summit of the mountain that is opposite the ravine of Onom toward the sea, which is from the region of the land of Raphain to the north,

9 and the boundary passes from the summit of the mountain to the spring of the water of Naphtho and passes to Mount Ephron, and the boundary leads out to Baal [this is the city of Iarim],

10 and the boundary shall go around from Baal toward the sea and pass to Mount Assares on the back, the city of Iarim on the north [this is Chaslon], and shall descend to the City of the Sun and pass to the south,

11 and the boundary shall pass by the back of Akkaron to the north, and the boundaries shall pass to Sakcharona and pass Mount Bala and pass to Jabnel, and the outlet of the boundaries shall be at the sea.

12 And their boundaries from the west: the Great Sea shall bound them. These are the boundaries of the sons of Judas all around according to their clans. –

13 And to Chaleb son of Jephonne he gave a portion among the sons of Judas by God’s command, and Jesus gave him the city of Arbok, chief city of Enak [this is Chebron].

14 And Chaleb son of Jephonne destroyed from there the three sons of Enak, Sousi and Tholmi and Achima.

15 And Chaleb went up from there against the inhabitants of Dabir; the name of Dabir had formerly been City of Letters.

16 And Chaleb said, “Whoever takes and cuts down the City of Letters and rules it, to him I shall give my daughter Achsa as a wife.”

17 And Gothoniel son of Kenez, the younger brother of Chaleb, took it, and he gave him his daughter Achsa as a wife.

18 And it happened as she was entering that she advised him, saying, “I shall ask my father for a field”; and she cried out from the donkey. And Chaleb said to her, “What is it with you?”

19 And she said to him, “Give me a blessing, because you gave me into the land of Nageb; give me Golathmain.” And Chaleb gave her Upper Golathmain and Lower Golathmain. –

20 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Judas.

21 And their cities were: the first city of the tribe of the sons of Judas at the boundaries of Edom in the wilderness, Kaibaiseleel and Ara and Asor

22 and Ikam and Regma and Arouel
23 and Kades and Asorionain
24 and Mainam and Balmainan and their villages
25 and the cities Aseron [this is Asor]
26 and Sen and Salmaa and Molada
27 and Seri and Baiphalad
28 and Cholaseola and Bersabee and their villages and their settlements,
29 Bala and Bakok and Asom
30 and Elbouda and Baethel and Erma
31 and Sekelak and Macharim and Sethennak
32 and Labos and Sale and Eromoth, twenty-nine cities and their villages.
33 In the plain: Astaol and Raa and Assa
34 and Ramen and Tano and Ilouthoth and Maiani
35 and Jermouth and Odollam and Membra and Saōcho and Azeka
36 and Sakarim and Gadera and its settlements, fourteen cities and their villages;
37 Senna and Adasan and Magadagad
38 and Dalal and Maspha and Jakareel
39 and Lachēs and Basedoth and Ideadalea
40 and Chabra and Maches and Maachos
41 and Geddor and Bagadiel and Noman and Makedan, sixteen cities and their villages;
42 Lemna and Ithak
43 and Anoch and Jana and Nasib
44 and Keilam and Akiezi and Kezib and Bathesar and Ailon, ten cities and their villages;
45 Akkaron and its villages and their settlements;
46 from Akkaron, Gemna and all those near Asedoth and their villages;
47 Asiedoth and its villages and its settlements; Gaza and its villages and its settlements as far as the torrent of Egypt; and the Great Sea bounds them.
48 And in the hill country: Samir and Jether and Socha
49 and Renna and City of Letters [this is Dabir]
50 and Anon and Eskaiman and Aisam
51 and Gosom and Chalou and Channa, eleven cities and their villages;
52 Airem and Remna and Soma
53 and Jemain and Baethachou and Phakoua

54 and Euma and City of Arbok [this is Chebron] and Sorth, nine cities and their settlements;

55 Maor and Chermel and Ozib and Itan

56 and Jariel and Jarikam and Zakanaiim

57 and Gabaa and Thamnatha, nine cities and their villages;

58 Aloua and Baethsour and Geddon

59 and Magaroth and Baethanam and Thekoum, six cities and their villages;

59 a Theko and Ephratha [this is Baethleem] and Phagor and Aitan and Koulon and Tatam and Eobes and Karem and Galem and Thether and Manocho, eleven cities and their villages;

60 Kariathbaal [this is the city of Iarim] and Sōtheba, two cities and their settlements;

61 and Baddargis and Tharabaam and Ainon and Aichioza

62 and Naphlazon and the cities Sadom and Ankades, seven cities and their villages.

63 And the Jebusite dwelt in Jerusalem, and the sons of Judas were not able to destroy them; and the Jebusites dwelt in Jerusalem until that day.

Chapter 16

1 And the boundaries of the sons of Joseph were from the Jordan by Jericho on the east, and it shall ascend from Jericho into the hill country, the wilderness, to Baethel Louza

2 and shall go out to Baethel and pass to the boundaries of Chatarothi

3 and shall pass toward the sea to the boundaries of Aptalim as far as the boundaries of Lower Baethoron, and their outlet shall be at the sea.

4 And the sons of Joseph, Ephraim and Manasse, inherited;

5 and the boundaries of the sons of Ephraim according to their clans were these: the boundaries of their inheritance from the east were Ataroth and Erok as far as Upper Baethoron and Gazara,

6 and the boundaries shall pass toward the sea to Ikasmon from north Therma, shall go around toward the east to Thenasa and Sellēsa and pass from the east to Janoka

7 and to Macho and Ataroth and their villages and come to Jericho and pass out to the Jordan,

8 and from Taphou the boundaries shall go toward the sea to Chelkana, and their outlet shall be at the sea; this is the inheritance of the tribe of Ephraim according to their clans.

9 And the cities set apart for the sons of Ephraim in the midst of the inheritance of the sons of Manasse, all the cities and their villages. –

10 And Ephraim did not destroy the Canaanite dwelling in Gazer, and the Canaanite dwelt in Ephraim until this day, until Pharaoh king of Egypt went up and took it and burned it with fire, and they pierced through the Canaanites and the Pherezites and those dwelling in Gazer, and Pharaoh gave it as a dowry to his daughter.

Chapter 17

1 And the boundaries of the tribe of the sons of Manasse were, because he was Joseph’s firstborn, for Machir, Manasse’s firstborn, father of Galaad [for he was a fighting man], in the Galaadite and Basanite regions.

2 And it was for the remaining sons of Manasse according to their clans, for the sons of Jezer and the sons of Kelez and the sons of Jeziel and the sons of Sychem and the sons of Symarim and the sons of Opher; these were the males according to their clans.

3 And Salpaad son of Opher had no sons but only daughters, and these are the names of Salpaad’s daughters: Maala and Noua and Egla and Melcha and Thersa.

4 And they stood before Eleazar the priest and before Jesus and before the rulers, saying, “God commanded through the hand of Moses to give us an inheritance among our brothers.” And an allotment was given them by the Lord’s command among their father’s brothers.

5 And their measured allotment fell from Anassa and the plain of Labek from Galaad, which is beyond the Jordan;

6 for the daughters of the sons of Manasse inherited an allotment among their brothers; but the land of Galaad became the portion of the sons of Manasse who remained.

7 And the boundaries of the sons of Manasse were Delanath, which is opposite the sons of Anath, and it goes along the boundaries to Jamin and Jassib to the spring Thaphthoth;

8 it shall be for Manasse, and Thapheth on the boundaries of Manasse for the sons of Ephraim.

9 And the boundaries shall descend to the ravine of Karana on the south along the ravine of Jariel, a terebinth for Ephraim in the midst of a city of Manasse; and the boundaries of Manasse to the north to the torrent, and its outlet shall be the sea.

10 From the south for Ephraim, and on the north Manasse, and the sea shall be their boundary; and they shall adjoin Aser on the north and Issachar on the east.

11 And for Manasse in Issachar and Aser shall be Baethsan and its villages and the inhabitants of Dor and its villages and the inhabitants of Mageddo and its villages and a third of Napheta and its villages.

12 And the sons of Manasse were not able to destroy these cities, and the Canaanite began to dwell in that land;

13 and it happened that when the sons of Israel grew strong, they made the Canaanites subject, but they did not destroy them utterly.

14 And the sons of Joseph answered Jesus, saying, “Why have you given us one lot and one measured portion as an inheritance? Yet I am a numerous people, and God has blessed me.”

15 And Jesus said to them, “If you are a numerous people, go up into the wooded land and clear it for yourself, if Mount Ephraim confines you.”

16 And they said, “Mount Ephraim will not suffice for us, and the Canaanite who dwells there in Baethsan and its villages in the valley of Jezrael has a chosen horse and iron.”

17 And Jesus said to the sons of Joseph, “If you are a numerous people and have great strength, you shall not have one lot;

18 for the wooded land shall be yours, because it is wooded land and you shall clear it and it shall be yours; and when you destroy the Canaanite, for he has a chosen horse, you are stronger than he.”

Chapter 18

1 And all the assembly of the sons of Israel was called together at Selo, and they pitched the tent of testimony there, and the land was held by them.

2 And seven tribes of the sons of Israel remained that had not inherited.

3 And Jesus said to the sons of Israel, “How long will you grow slack about inheriting the land that the Lord our God gave?

4 Give three men from each tribe from among you, and let them arise and go through the land and draw it out before me as it must be divided. [And they came to him,

5 and he divided it for them into seven portions.] Judas shall be their boundary on the south, and the sons of Joseph shall be theirs on the north.

6 But you divide the land into seven portions and bring them to me here, and I shall bring out a lot for you before the Lord our God.

7 For the sons of Levi have no portion among you, for the Lord’s priesthood is his portion; and Gad and Reuben and the half tribe of Manasse received their inheritance beyond the Jordan on the east that Moses the servant of the Lord gave them.”

8 And the men arose and went, and Jesus commanded the men going to traverse the land, saying, “Go and traverse the land and come to me, and here I shall bring out a lot for you before the Lord in Selo.”

9 And they went and traversed the land and saw it and wrote it by its cities in seven portions in a book and brought it to Jesus.

10 And Jesus cast a lot for them in Selo before the Lord.

11 And the lot of the tribe of Benjamin came out first according to their clans, and the boundaries of their lot came out between Judas and the sons of Joseph.

12 And their boundaries from the north were from the Jordan; the boundary shall ascend behind Jericho on the north and ascend to the mountain toward the sea, and its outlet shall be the Madbarite region of Baethon,

13 and the boundary shall pass from there to Louza behind Louza on the south [this is Baethel], and the boundary shall descend to Maatarothorech to the hill country south of Lower Baethoron,

14 and the boundary shall pass and go around to the side facing toward the sea from the south of the mountain opposite Baethoron to the south, and its outlet shall be to Kariathbaal [this is Kariathiarin, a city of the sons of Judas]; this is the side toward the sea.

15 And the southern side from the region of Kariathbaal, and the boundary shall pass to Gasin at the spring of the water of Naphtho,

16 and the boundary shall descend to the region of the mountain opposite the wooded valley of Onnam, which is in the region of Emekraphain on the north, and shall descend to Gaienna behind Jebusai on the south and descend to the spring Rogel

17 and pass to the spring Baethsamys and pass to Galiloth, which is opposite the ascent of Aithamin, and descend to the stone of Baion of the sons of Reuben

18 and pass behind Baetharaba on the north and descend

19 to the boundaries behind Baethagla on the north, and the outlet of the boundaries shall be to the ridge of the Salt Sea on the north at the region of the Jordan on the south; these are the boundaries from the south.

20 And the Jordan shall bound it from the eastern side. This is the inheritance of the sons of Benjamin, its boundaries all around according to clans. –

21 And the cities of the sons of Benjamin according to their clans were Jericho and Baetheglio and Amekasis

22 and Baethabara and Sara and Besana

23 and Aiin and Phara and Ephratha

24 and Karapha and Kephira and Moni and Gabaa, twelve cities and their villages;

25 Gabaon and Rama and Beerotha

26 and Massema and Miron and Amoke

27 and Phira and Kaphan and Nakan and Selekan and Thareela

28 and Jebus [this is Jerusalem] and cities and Gabaothiarim, thirteen cities and their villages. This is the inheritance of the sons of Benjamin according to their clans.

Chapter 19

1 And the second lot of the sons of Symeon came out, and their inheritance was in the midst of the allotments of the sons of Judas.

2 And their lot was Bersabee and Samaa and Koladam

3 and Arsola and Bola and Asom

4 and Elthoula and Boula and Erma

5 and Sikelak and Baethmachereb and Sarsousin

6 and Batharoth and their fields, thirteen cities and their villages;

7 Eremmon and Thalcha and Ether and Asan, four cities and their villages

8 around their cities as far as Barek, going to Bameth toward the south. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Symeon according to their clans.

9 From the lot of Judas was the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Symeon, because the portion of the sons of Judas was greater than theirs; and the sons of Symeon inherited in the midst of their lot.

10 And the third lot came out for Zabulon according to their clans. The boundaries of their inheritance shall be Esedek,

11 Gola; their boundaries were the sea and Maragella and shall join Baetharaba at the ravine opposite Jekman,

12 and it turned from Sedduk opposite, from the east of Baethsamys to the boundaries of Chaselothaith, and shall pass to Dabiroth and ascend to Phanggai

13 and from there shall go around opposite on the east to Gebere to the city of Katasem and shall pass to Remmona Amathar Aoza

14 and the boundary shall go around on the north to Amoth, and their outlet shall be at Gaiphael

15 and Katanath and Nabaal and Symoon and Jericho and Baethman.

16 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Zabulon according to their clans, cities and their villages.

17 And for Issachar the fourth lot came out.

18 And their boundaries were Jazel and Chasaloth and Sounan

19 and Agin and Siona and Reeroth and Anachereth

20 and Dabiron and Kison and Rebes

21 and Remmas and Jeon and Tomman and Aimarek and Bersaphes,

22 and the boundaries shall join Gaithbor and Salim toward the sea and Baethsamys, and its boundary outlet shall be the Jordan.

23 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Issachar according to their clans, the cities and their villages.

24 And the fifth lot came out for Aser.

25 And their boundaries were from Eleketh and Aleph and Baethok and Keaph

26 and Elimelek and Amiel and Maasa, and it will join Carmel by the sea and Sion and Labanath

27 and it will turn from the rising of the sun and Baithegeneth and will join Zabulon, and from Gai and Phthaiel toward the north, and the boundaries will enter Saphthaibaithme and Inael and will pass into Choba Masomel

28 and Elbon and Raab and Ememaon and Kanthan as far as great Sidon,

29 and the boundaries will turn to Rama and as far as the spring of Masphassat and of the Tyrians, and the boundaries will turn toward Iasiph, and its outlet will be the sea and from Leb and Echozob

30 and Archob and Aphek and Raau.

31 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Aser according to their divisions, cities and their villages.

32 And for Nephthali the sixth lot came out.

33 And their boundaries were Moolam and Mola and Besemiin and Arme and Nabok and Iephthamai as far as Dodam, and its outlets were the Jordan;

34 and the boundaries will turn toward the sea to Enath Thabor and will pass from there to Iakana and will join Zabulon from the south, and Aser will join toward the sea, and the Jordan from the rising of the sun.

35 And the walled cities of the Tyrians: Tyre and Omatha, Daketh and Kenereth

36 and Armaith and Arael and Asor

37 and Kades and Assari and the spring of Asor

38 and Keroe and Megala, Arim and Baiththame and Thessamys.

39 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Nephthali.

40 And for Dan the seventh lot came out.

41 And their boundaries were Sarath and Asa, the cities Sammaus

42 and Salabin and Ammon and Silatha

43 and Ailon and Thamnatha and Akkaron

44 and Alkatha and Begethon and Gebeelan

45 and Azor and Banaibakat and Gethremmon,

46 and from the sea Ierakon, a boundary near Ioppe.

47 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Dan according to their divisions, their cities and their villages.

47 a And the sons of Dan did not drive out the Amorite who was pressing them in the mountain; and the Amorites did not allow them to descend into the valley and pressed away from them the boundary of their portion.

48 And the sons of Judah went and fought Lachis and took it and struck it with the edge of the sword and inhabited it and called its name Lasendak.

48 a And the Amorite persisted in dwelling in Elom and in Salamin; and the hand of Ephraim was heavy upon them, and they became tribute for them.

49 And they went to take possession of the land according to their boundary. And the sons of Israel gave a lot to Jesus the son of Naue among them

50 by command of God; and they gave him the city that he asked for, Thamnasarach, which is in the mountain of Ephraim; and he built the city and dwelt in it.

51 These are the divisions which Eleazar the priest and Jesus the son of Naue and the chiefs of the fathers' houses among the tribes of Israel distributed by lot in Selo before the Lord beside the doors of the tent of testimony; and they went to take possession of the land.

Chapter 20

1 And the Lord spoke to Jesus, saying,

2 Speak to the sons of Israel, saying: Give the cities of places of refuge, which I spoke to you through Moses,

3 a place of refuge for the slayer who struck a soul unintentionally; and the cities shall be for you a place of refuge, and the slayer shall not die at the hand of the one who is next of kin to the blood, until he stands before the congregation for judgment.

7 And he set apart Kades in Galilee in the mountain of Nephthali, and Sychem in the mountain of Ephraim, and the city of Arbok [this is Chebron] in the mountain of Judah.

8 And beyond the Jordan he gave Bosor in the wilderness in the plain from the tribe of Rouben, and Aremoth in Galaad from the tribe of Gad, and Gaulon in Basanitis from the tribe of Manasse.

9 These are the cities designated for the sons of Israel and for the sojourner attached among them, for everyone striking a soul unintentionally to flee there, so that he might not die by the hand of the one who is next of kin to the blood, until he stands before the congregation for judgment.

Chapter 21

1 And the heads of the fathers' houses of the sons of Levi approached Eleazar the priest and Jesus the son of Naue and the chiefs of the tribes of the fathers' houses from the tribes of Israel

2 and said to them in Selo in the land of Canaan, saying: The Lord commanded by the hand of Moses to give us cities to dwell in and the surrounding lands for our cattle.

3 And the sons of Israel gave the Levites, in the allotting of inheritance by command of the Lord, the cities and their surrounding lands.

4 And the lot came out for the division of Kaath, and for the sons of Aaron, the priests, the Levites, from the tribe of Judah and from the tribe of Symeon and from the tribe of Benjamin, there were by lot thirteen cities,

5 and for the sons of Kaath who remained, from the tribe of Ephraim and from the tribe of Dan and from the half tribe of Manasse, by lot ten cities;

6 and for the sons of Gedson, from the tribe of Issachar and from the tribe of Aser and from the tribe of Nephthali and from the half tribe of Manasse in Basan, thirteen cities;

7 and for the sons of Merari according to their divisions, from the tribe of Rouben and from the tribe of Gad and from the tribe of Zabulon, by lot twelve cities.

8 And the sons of Israel gave the Levites the cities and their surrounding lands, in the manner the Lord commanded Moses, by lot.

9 And the tribe of the sons of Judah and the tribe of the sons of Symeon and from the tribe of the sons of Benjamin gave the cities, and they were named

10 for the sons of Aaron from the division of Kaath of the sons of Levi, because the lot fell to these.

11 And he gave them Kariatharbok, the mother city of the Enak [this is Chebron], in the mountain of Judah; but the surrounding lands around it

12 and the fields of the city and its villages Jesus gave to the sons of Chaleb son of Iephonne as a possession;

13 and to the sons of Aaron the city of refuge for the slayer, Chebron, and the lands set apart with it, and Lemna and the lands set apart beside it,

14 and Ailom and the lands set apart for it, and Tema and the lands set apart for it,

15 and Gella and the lands set apart for it, and Dabir and the lands set apart for it,

16 and Asa and the lands set apart for it, and Tany and the lands set apart for it, and Baithsamys and the lands set apart for it, nine cities from these two tribes.

17 And from the tribe of Benjamin, Gabaon and the lands set apart for it, and Gathed and the lands set apart for it,

18 and Anathoth and the lands set apart for it, and Gamala and the lands set apart for it, four cities.

19 All the cities of the sons of Aaron the priests: thirteen.

20 And for the divisions of the sons of Kaath, the Levites who remained of the sons of Kaath, there was a city of their boundaries from the tribe of Ephraim,

21 and they gave them the city of refuge for the slayer, Sychem, and the lands set apart for it, and Gazara and the things beside it and the lands set apart for it,

22 and Kabsaim and the lands set apart beside it, and upper Baithoron and the lands set apart for it, four cities.

23 And from the tribe of Dan, Elkothaim and the lands set apart for it, and Gethedan and the lands set apart for it,

24 and Ailon and the lands set apart for it, and Gethremmon and the lands set apart for it, four cities.

25 And from the half tribe of Manasse, Tanach and the lands set apart for it, and Iebatha and the lands set apart for it, two cities.

26 All the cities: ten, and the lands set apart beside them, for the divisions of the sons of Kaath who remained.

27 And for the sons of Gedson, the Levites, from the half tribe of Manasse, the cities set apart for the slayers: Gaulon in Basanitis and the lands set apart for it, and Bosoran and the lands set apart for it, two cities,

28 and from the tribe of Issachar, Kison and the lands set apart for it, and Debba and the lands set apart for it,

29 and Remmath and the lands set apart for it, and the Spring of Letters and the lands set apart for it, four cities.

30 And from the tribe of Aser, Basellan and the lands set apart for it, and Dabbon and the lands set apart for it,

31 and Chelkat and the lands set apart for it, and Raab and the lands set apart for it, four cities.

32 And from the tribe of Nephthali, the city set apart for the slayer, Kades in Galilee, and the lands set apart for it, and Emmath and the lands set apart for it, and Themmon and the lands set apart for it, three cities.

33 All the cities of Gedson according to their divisions: thirteen cities.

34 And for the division of the sons of Merari, the remaining Levites, from the tribe of the sons of Zabulon, Maan and its surrounding lands, and Kades and its surrounding lands,

35 and Demna and its surrounding lands, and Sella and its surrounding lands, four cities.

36 And beyond the Jordan opposite Iericho, from the tribe of Rouben, the city of refuge for the slayer, Bosor in the wilderness, in Misor, and its surrounding lands, and Iazer and its surrounding lands,

37 and Dekmon and its surrounding lands, and Mapha and its surrounding lands, four cities.

38 And from the tribe of Gad, the city of refuge for the slayer, Ramoth in Galaad and its surrounding lands, and Kamin and its surrounding lands,

39 and Esebon and its surrounding lands, and Iazer and its surrounding lands; all the cities: four.

40 All the cities for the sons of Merari according to their divisions, those remaining of the tribe of Levi; and the boundaries were twelve cities.

41 All the cities of the Levites in the midst of the possession of the sons of Israel: forty-eight cities and their surrounding lands

42 around these cities, a city and the surrounding lands around the city, for all these cities.

42 a And Jesus finished dividing the land within their boundaries.

43 And the sons of Israel gave Jesus a portion according to the command of the Lord; they gave him the city which he asked for; they gave him Thamnasarach in the mountain of Ephraim.

44 And Jesus built the city and dwelt in it.

45 And Jesus took the stone knives with which he circumcised the sons of Israel who were born on the way in the wilderness, and placed them in Thamnasarach.

43 And the Lord gave Israel all the land which he swore to give to their fathers, and they inherited it and dwelt in it.

44 And the Lord gave them rest all around, just as he swore to their fathers; no one of all their enemies stood before them; the Lord delivered all their enemies into their hands.

45 Not one of all the good words which the Lord spoke to the sons of Israel fell away; all came to pass.

Chapter 22

1 Then Jesus called together the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of Manasse

2 and said to them: You have heard all that Moses the servant of the Lord commanded you, and you listened to my voice in all that I commanded you.

3 You have not abandoned your brothers these days and more, until this day; you kept the command of the Lord your God.

4 And now the Lord our God has given our brothers rest, in the manner he told them; now therefore turn and go to your houses and to the land of your possession, which Moses gave you beyond the Jordan.

5 But take great care to do the commandments and the law which Moses the servant of the Lord commanded us to do: to love the Lord your God, to walk in all his ways, to keep his commandments and to cling to him and to serve him with all your mind and with all your soul.

6 And Jesus blessed them and sent them away, and they went to their houses. –

7 And to half the tribe of Manasse Moses gave in Basanitis, and to the half Jesus gave with his brothers beyond the Jordan toward the sea. And when Jesus sent them away to their houses and blessed them,

8 then with many possessions they went to their houses, and very many cattle and silver and gold and iron and much clothing, and they divided the spoil of the enemies with their brothers.

9 And the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of the sons of Manasse departed from the sons of Israel from Selo in the land of Canaan to go to the land of Galaad, to the land of their possession which they inherited by command of the Lord by the hand of Moses.

10 And they came to Galgala of the Jordan, which is in the land of Canaan, and the sons of Gad and the sons of Rouben and the half tribe of Manasse built there an altar on the Jordan, a great altar to behold.

11 And the sons of Israel heard people saying: Behold, the sons of Gad and the sons of Rouben and the half tribe of Manasse built an altar at the boundaries of the land of Canaan, at Galaad of the Jordan, across from the sons of Israel.

12 And all the sons of Israel gathered at Selo to go up and wage war against them.

13 And the sons of Israel sent to the sons of Rouben and to the sons of Gad and to the half tribe of Manasse in the land of Galaad Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the high priest

14 and ten of the rulers with him, one ruler from a father's house from each of the tribes of Israel; they are rulers of fathers' houses, commanders of thousands of Israel.

15 And they came to the sons of Gad and to the sons of Rouben and to the halves of the tribe of Manasse in the land of Galaad and spoke to them, saying:

16 Thus says the whole congregation of the Lord: What is this offense that you have committed before the God of Israel, to turn away today from the Lord, building an altar for yourselves, that you might become rebels against the Lord?

17 Is the sin of Phogor a small thing for us? For we have not been cleansed from it until this day, and a plague came upon the congregation of the Lord.

18 And will you turn away today from the Lord? And it will be, if you rebel today against the Lord, tomorrow wrath will be upon all Israel.

19 And now if the land of your possession is small for you, cross into the land of the Lord's possession, where the tent of the Lord dwells, and inherit among us; and do not become rebels against God and do not rebel against the Lord by your building an altar apart from the altar of the Lord our God.

20 Was it not Achar son of Zara who committed an offense from the devoted thing, and wrath came upon all the congregation of Israel? And he was one man alone; did he alone die for his own sin?

21 And the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of Manasse answered and spoke to the commanders of thousands of Israel, saying:

22 God is God, the Lord, and God is God, the Lord; he himself knows, and Israel itself will know. If we committed an offense in rebellion before the Lord, may he not deliver us in this;

23 and if we built an altar for ourselves so as to rebel against the Lord our God, so as to offer upon it a sacrifice of whole burnt offerings or to make upon it a sacrifice of deliverance, the Lord will seek it out.

24 But because of concern about a word we did this, saying: Lest tomorrow your children say to our children: What have you to do with the Lord the God of Israel?

25 And the Lord set the Jordan as a boundary between us and you, and there is no portion of the Lord for you. And your sons will estrange our sons, so that they do not revere the Lord.

26 And we said to do thus, to build this altar, not for offerings nor for sacrifices,

27 but so that this may be a witness between us and you and between our generations after us, to perform service to the Lord before him with our offerings and with our sacrifices and with our sacrifices of deliverance; and your children will not say to our children tomorrow: There is no portion of the Lord for you.

28 And we said: If ever it happens that they speak to us and to our generations tomorrow, then they will say: See the likeness of the altar of the Lord, which our fathers made not for offerings nor for sacrifices, but it is a witness between you and us and between our sons.

29 May it not happen, then, that we turn away from the Lord in these days, to rebel against the Lord so as to build an altar for offerings and sacrifices of salamin and for a sacrifice of deliverance, besides the altar of the Lord which is before his tent.

30 And Phinees the priest and all the rulers of the congregation of Israel who were with him heard the words which the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of Manasse spoke, and it pleased them.

31 And Phinees the priest said to the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of Manasse: Today we have known that the Lord is with us, because you have not committed an offense before the Lord, and because you have delivered the sons of Israel from the hand of the Lord.

32 And Phinees the priest and the rulers returned from the sons of Rouben and from the sons of Gad and from the half tribe of Manasse, from the land of Galaad to the land of Canaan, to the sons of Israel, and reported the words to them,

33 and it pleased the sons of Israel. And they spoke to the sons of Israel, and they blessed the God of the sons of Israel and said that they would no longer go up against them in war to destroy the land of the sons of Rouben and the sons of Gad and the half tribe of Manasse. And they dwelt upon it.

34 And Jesus named the altar of the Roubenites and the Gadites and the half tribe of Manasse and said: It is a witness between them that the Lord is their God.

Chapter 23

1 And it happened after many days, after the Lord had given Israel rest from all their enemies round about, and Jesus was old, advanced in days,

2 that Jesus called together all the sons of Israel and their council of elders and their rulers and their scribes and their judges and said to them: I have grown old and advanced in days.

3 And you have seen all that the Lord your God did to all these nations before you, for it was the Lord your God who fought for you.

4 See that I have cast to you these nations remaining for you among the lots for your tribes; from the Jordan, all the nations which I destroyed, and from the great sea it will bound toward the setting of the sun.

5 And the Lord your God, he will destroy them from before you until they perish, and will send wild beasts against them until he destroys them and their kings from before you, and you will inherit their land, just as the Lord your God spoke to you.

6 Be very strong, then, to keep and do all the things written in the book of the law of Moses, so that you do not turn aside to the right or the left,

7 so that you do not go in among these remaining nations, and the names of their gods shall not be named among you, nor shall you bow down to them or serve them,

8 but you shall cleave to the Lord your God, just as you have done until this day.

9 And the Lord destroyed them from before you, great and strong nations, and no one stood against you before you until this day;

10 one of you pursued a thousand, because the Lord your God fought for you, just as he told you.

11 And take great care to love the Lord your God.

12 For if you turn away and attach yourselves to these remaining nations that are with you, and make marriages with them and mingle with them and they with you,

13 know that the Lord will no longer continue to destroy these nations from before you, and they will be snares and stumbling blocks for you and nails in your heels and darts in your eyes, until you perish from this good land which the Lord your God gave you.

14 And I am running the way, as also all those on the earth, and you will know in your heart and in your soul that not one word of all the words that the Lord your God spoke concerning all that pertains to you fell away; none of them failed.

15 And it will be that, in the manner all the good words which the Lord spoke to you have come upon you, so the Lord God will bring upon you all the evil words until he destroys you from this good land which the Lord gave you,

16 when you transgress the covenant of the Lord your God which he commanded you, and go and serve other gods and bow down to them.

Chapter 24

1 And Jesus gathered all the tribes of Israel at Selo and called together their elders and their scribes and their judges and stood them before God.

2 And Jesus said to all the people: Thus says the Lord the God of Israel: Beyond the river your fathers dwelt from the beginning, Thara the father of Abraham and the father of Nachor, and they served other gods.

3 And I took your father Abraham from beyond the river and led him in all the land and multiplied his seed and gave him Isaac,

4 and to Isaac Jacob and Esau; and I gave Esau Mount Seir for him to inherit, and Jacob and his sons went down into Egypt and became there a great and numerous and strong nation.

5 And the Egyptians afflicted them, and the Lord struck Egypt with the things he did to them, and after these things he brought you out

6 from Egypt, and you entered the Red Sea. And the Egyptians pursued after your fathers with chariots and horses into the Red Sea,

7 and we cried out to the Lord, and he placed a cloud and darkness between us and the Egyptians and brought the sea upon them and covered them, and your eyes saw all that the Lord did in the land of Egypt. And you were in the wilderness many days.

8 And he led you into the land of the Amorites who dwelt beyond the Jordan, and they drew up for battle against you, and the Lord delivered them into your hands, and you inherited their land and destroyed them from before you.

9 And Balak son of Sepphor, king of Moab, arose and drew up for battle against Israel and sent and called Balaam to curse you;

10 and the Lord your God did not wish to destroy you, and he blessed you with a blessing, and rescued you from their hands and delivered them.

11 And you crossed the Jordan and came to Iericho; and the inhabitants of Iericho fought against you, the Amorite and the Canaanite and the Pherezite and the Euaite and the Iebusite and the Chettite and the Gergesite, and the Lord delivered them into your hands.

12 And he sent the hornet ahead of you, and drove them out from before you, twelve kings of the Amorites, not by your sword or by your bow.

13 And he gave you land on which you did not labor, and cities which you did not build, and you settled in them; and vineyards and olive groves which you did not plant, you will eat.

14 And now fear the Lord and serve him in uprightness and in righteousness, and remove the foreign gods whom your fathers served beyond the river and in Egypt, and serve the Lord.

15 But if it does not please you to serve the Lord, choose for yourselves today whom you will serve, whether the gods of your fathers beyond the river or the gods of the Amorites in whose land you dwell; but I and my house will serve the Lord, for he is holy.

16 And the people answered and said: May it not happen to us to abandon the Lord so as to serve other gods.

17 The Lord our God, he is God; he brought us and our fathers up from Egypt and guarded us in all the way in which we went and among all the nations through whom we passed;

18 and the Lord drove out the Amorite and all the nations dwelling in the land from before us. But we too will serve the Lord, for he is our God.

19 And Jesus said to the people: You will not be able to serve the Lord, for he is a holy God, and being zealous he will not release your sins and your lawless deeds;

20 whenever you abandon the Lord and serve other gods, he will come and afflict you and consume you in return for his having done you good.

21 And the people said to Jesus: No, but we will serve the Lord.

22 And Jesus said to the people: You are witnesses against yourselves that you chose the Lord to serve him;

23 and now remove the foreign gods among you and direct your heart toward the Lord God of Israel.

24 And the people said to Jesus: We will serve the Lord and listen to his voice.

25 And Jesus made a covenant with the people on that day and gave them a law and a judgment in Selo before the tent of the God of Israel.

26 And he wrote these words in a book, a law of God; and Jesus took a great stone and set it under the terebinth before the Lord.

27 And Jesus said to the people: Behold, this stone will be a witness among you, for it has heard all that was said to it by the Lord, whatever he spoke to us today; and it will be a witness among you at the last of the days, whenever you lie to the Lord my God.

28 And Jesus sent the people away, and each went to his place.

29 And Israel served the Lord all the days of Jesus and all the days of the elders who prolonged their time after Jesus and who saw all the works of the Lord which he did for Israel.

30 And it happened after those things that Jesus son of Naue, servant of the Lord, died at one hundred and ten years of age.

31 And they buried him by the boundaries of his lot at Thamnathasachara in the mountain of Ephraim to the north of Mount Gaas;

31 a There they placed with him in the tomb in which they buried him there the stone knives with which he circumcised the sons of Israel at Galgalois when he brought them out of Egypt, as the Lord directed them, and they are there until this day. –

32 And the sons of Israel brought Joseph's bones up from Egypt and buried them in Sikimois in the portion of the field which Jacob acquired from the Amorites dwelling in Sikimois for a hundred lambs, and he gave it to Joseph as a portion.

33 And it happened after these things that Eleazar son of Aaron the high priest died and was buried in Gabaath of Phinees his son, which he gave him in the mountain of Ephraim.

33 a On that day the sons of Israel took the ark of God and carried it about among themselves, and Phinees served as priest in place of Eleazar his father until he died and was buried in his own Gabaath.

34 And the sons of Israel departed, each to their place and to their own city. And the sons of Israel revered Astarte and Astaroth and the gods of the nations around them; and the Lord delivered them into the hands of Eglom the king of Moab, and he ruled them for eighteen years. Kabseel and Edrai and Iagour

22 and Kina and Dimona and Adada

23 and Kedes and Ithnaziph

24 and Telem and Baloth

25 and the city of Aseron [this is Asor],

26 Amam and Samaa and Molada

27 and Asergadda and Baithphaleth

28 and Asarsoula and Bersabee and their villages and their settlements,

29 Baala and Auim and Asem

30 and Elthodad and Chasil and Erma

31 and Sikeleg and Medebena and Sansanna

32 and Laboth and Seleim and Remmon, twenty-nine cities and their villages.

33 In the plain: Esthaol and Saraa and Asna

34 and Ramen and Zano and Adiathaim and Enaim

35 and Ierimouth and Odollam and Nemra and Socho and Azeka

36 and Sargarim and Gadera and its settlements, fourteen cities and their villages;

37 Sennan and Adasa and Magdalgalad

38 and Dalaan and Maspha and Iechthael

39 and Lachis and Bazkath and Aglon

40 and Chabba and Lamas and Chathlos

41 and Gaderoth and Bethdagon and Noma and Makeda, sixteen cities and their villages;

42 Lebna and Ather

43 and Iephtha and Asenna and Nesib

44 and Keila and Achzib and Maresa and Edom, nine cities and their villages;

45 Akkaron and its villages and its settlements;

46 and from Akkaron Iemnai and all that are near Asdod, and the villages

47 and its settlements; Gaza and its villages and its settlements as far as the torrent of Egypt; and the great sea forms the boundary.

48 And in the hill country: Saphir and Iether and Socho

49 and Renna, a city of letters [this is Dabir],

50 and Anob and Esthemo and Anim

51 and Gosom and Chilouon and Gelon, ten cities and their villages;

52 Ereb and Esan and Rouma

53 and Ianoum and Baiththapphoue and Aphaka

54 and Chammata and the city of Arbo [this is Chebron] and Sior, nine cities and their villages;

55 Maon and Chermel and Ziph and Ietta

56 and Iezrael and Iekdaam and Zanoakim

57 and Gabaa and Thamna, nine cities and their villages;

58 Aloul and Baithsour and Gedor

59 and Maroth and Baithanoth and Eltheken, six cities and their villages;

59 a Theko and Ephratha [this is Bethlehem] and Phagor and Aitam and Koulon and Tatami and Soreis and Karem and Gallim and Baither and Manocho, eleven cities and their villages;

60 Kariathbaal [this is the city of Iarim] and Arebba, two cities and their villages and their settlements;

61 Baddargis and Betharaba and Madon and Sochocha

62 and Nebsan and the cities of salt and Engaddi, seven cities and their villages. Bethagla and Amekkasis

22 and Baitharaba and Semrim and Bethel

23 and Auim and Aphar and Aphra

24 and Aikaren and Kaphirammim and Gabaa, twelve cities and their villages;

25 Gabaon and Rama and Beroth

26 and Maspha and Chephira and Amosa

27 and Rekem and Ierphael and Tharala

28 and Selaleph and Iebous [this is Jerusalem] and Gabaath and the city of Iarim, thirteen cities and their villages. This is the inheritance of the sons of Benjamin according to their divisions.

Chapter 19

1 And the second lot came out for Symeon, and their inheritance was in the midst of the lot of the sons of Judah.

2 And their lot was Bersabee and Sabee and Molada

3 and Asersoual and Bathoul and Bola and Asom

4 and Elthoulad and Erma

5 and Sekela and Baithammarchaboth and Asersousim

6 and Baithlabath and their fields, thirteen cities and their villages;

7 Ain and Remmon and Ether and Asan, four cities and their villages

8 around these cities as far as Baalethberramoth of those going to Iameth toward the southwest. This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Symeon according to their divisions.

9 From the lot of Judah was the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Symeon, because the portion of the sons of Judah was greater than theirs; and the sons of Symeon inherited in the midst of their lot.

10 And the third lot came out for Zabulon according to their divisions. And the boundaries of their inheritance will be as far as Sarid;

11 their boundaries, the sea and Marala, and it will join at Dabasthai in the ravine that is opposite Ieknam,

12 and it will turn from Sarid opposite, from the rising of Sams, toward the boundaries of Chasaloth Thabor and pass toward Dabrath and go up further toward Iaphagai

13 and from there go around opposite toward the east to Geththa to the city Kasim and pass toward Remmon Ammatharim Annoua

14 and go around to the northern boundaries toward Ennathoth, and their outlet will be toward Gaiiephthael

15 and Kattath and Naalol and Semron and Iadela and Bethlehem.

16 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Zabulon according to their divisions, these cities and their villages.

17 And for Issachar the fourth lot came out.

18 And their boundaries were Iezrael and Achaseloth and Sounam

19 and Apheraiim and Sian and Renath and Anareth

20 and Rabboth and Kesion and Aeme

21 and Ramath and Engannim and Enadda and Baithphases,

22 and the boundaries will join at Thaboth and at Sasima toward the sea and Baithsmas, and the outlet of their boundaries will be the Jordan.

23 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Issachar according to their divisions, the cities and their settlements.

24 And the fifth lot came out for Aser according to their divisions.

25 And their boundaries were Chelkath and Ooli and Batne and Achsaph

26 and Amad and Masal, and it will join Carmel toward the sea and Sior and Labanath

27 and it will turn from the rising of the sun to Bethdagon and join Zabulon and in the valley of Iephthael toward the north, and the boundaries will enter Saphthabethaemek and the border will go to Aniel and pass into Chabol on the left

28 and Achran and Roob and Amon and Kana as far as great Sidon,

29 and the boundaries will turn to Rama and as far as the fortified city of the Tyrians, and the boundaries will turn toward Osa, and its outlet will be the sea and from the measured portion of Achziph

30 and Amma and Aphek and Raob, twenty-two cities.

31 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Aser according to their divisions, their cities and their villages.

32 And for Nephthali the sixth lot came out.

33 And their boundaries were Meeleph and Maelon and Besenanim and Armai and Nakeb and Iabnel as far as Lakou, and its outlets were the Jordan;

34 and the boundaries will turn toward the sea to Azanoth Thabor and pass from there to Ikok and join Zabulon from the south and join Aser toward the sea, and the Jordan from the rising of the sun.

35 And the walled cities of the Tyrians: Tyre and Amath and Rekkath and Chenereth

36 and Adami and Rama and Asor

37 and Kedes and Edrai and the spring of Asor

38 and Iarion and Magdaliel, Oram and Baithanath and Thasmous, nineteen cities.

39 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the sons of Nephthali.

40 And for Dan the seventh lot came out.

41 And their boundaries were Saraa and Esthaol and the city Sames

42 and Salabin and Iaalon and Iethla

43 and Ailon and Thamna and Akkaron

44 and Eltheko and Gabathon and Baalon

45 and Iouth and Banebarak and Gethremmon,

1 Judges

Chapter 1

1 And it happened after the death of Jesus that the sons of Israel asked in the Lord, saying: Who will go up for us against the Canaanite, taking the lead to fight against him?

2 And the Lord said: Judah will go up; behold, I have given the land into his hand.

3 And Judah said to Symeon his brother: Come up with me in my lot, and let us fight against the Canaanite, and I too will go with you in your lot. And Symeon went with him.

4 And Judah went up, and the Lord gave the Canaanite and the Pherezite into his hand, and he struck them at Bezek, ten thousand men,

5 and they found Adonibezek at Bezek and fought against him and struck the Canaanite and the Pherezite.

6 And Adonibezek fled, and they pursued after him and took him and cut off the extremities of his hands and his feet.

7 And Adonibezek said: Seventy kings, the extremities of their hands and their feet cut off, were gathering what was under my table; as I did, so God has repaid me. And they brought him to Jerusalem, and he died there.

8 And the sons of Judah fought in Jerusalem and took it and struck it with the edge of the sword and burned the city with fire.

9 And after these things the sons of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanite dwelling in the hill country and the south and the plain.

10 And Judah went against the Canaanite dwelling in Chebron, and Chebron came out opposite; but the name of Chebron formerly was Kariatharboksepher. And he struck Sesi and Achiman and Tholmi, offspring of Enak.

11 And they went from there against those dwelling in Dabir; and the name of Dabir formerly was City of Letters.

12 And Chaleb said: Whoever strikes the City of Letters and takes it first, I will give him Aschan my daughter for a wife.

13 And Gothoniel son of Kenez, the younger brother of Chaleb, took it first, and he gave him Aschan his daughter for a wife.

14 And it happened as she was going in that he urged her to ask her father for the field, and she murmured upon the beast of burden and cried out from the beast of burden: You have given me away into a land of the south. And Chaleb said to her: What is it for you?

15 And Ascha said to him: Give me a blessing, because you have given me away into a land of the south, and you will give me a redemption of water. And Chaleb gave her according to her heart the redemption of the heights and the redemption of the lowlands.

16 And the sons of Iobab the Kenite, father-in-law of Moses, went up from the city of palms with the sons of Judah into the wilderness that is in the south by the descent of Arad, and he went and dwelt with the people. –

17 And Judah went with Symeon his brother and they struck the Canaanite dwelling in Sepheth and devoted it and destroyed it and called the name of the city Destruction.

18 And Judah did not inherit Gaza and its boundary and Ascalon and its boundary and Akkaron and its boundary and Azotus and its surrounding lands.

19 And the Lord was with Judah, and he inherited the mountain; because he was not able to inherit those dwelling in the valley, because Rechab had divided it.

20 And he gave Chebron to Chaleb, as Moses spoke; and he inherited from there the three cities and removed from there the three sons of Enak.

21 And the sons of Benjamin did not remove the Iebusite dwelling in Jerusalem, and the Iebusite dwelt with the sons of Benjamin until this day.

22 And the sons of Joseph, they too, went up to Bethel, and Judah with them.

23 And the house of Israel encamped against Bethel; but the name of the city formerly was Louza.

24 And those keeping watch saw a man going out of the city and took him and said to him: Show us the entrance of the city, and we will deal mercifully with you.

25 And he showed them the entrance of the city, and they struck the city with the edge of the sword, but the man and his kin they sent away.

26 And the man departed to the land of the Chettites and built a city there and called its name Louza; that is its name until this day.

27 And Manasse did not inherit Baithsan, which is the city of the Scythians, nor its daughter towns nor its surrounding lands, nor Ekthanaad and its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Dor and its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Balaam and its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Magedon and its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Ieblaam nor its daughter towns; and the Canaanite began to dwell in this land.

28 And it happened when Israel grew strong that he put the Canaanite to tribute, and in removing him he did not remove him.

29 And Ephraim did not remove the Canaanite dwelling in Gazer; and the Canaanite dwelt in his midst in Gazer and became tribute.

30 And Zabulon did not remove those dwelling in Kedron and those dwelling in Enaala; and the Canaanite dwelt in his midst and became tribute.

31 And Aser did not remove those dwelling in Akcho, and it became tribute for him, nor those dwelling in Dor and those dwelling in Sidon and those dwelling in Aalaph and Achazib and Chelba and Aphek and Roob.

32 And Aser dwelt in the midst of the Canaanite dwelling in the land, because he was unable to remove him.

33 And Nephthali did not remove those dwelling in Baithsamys nor those dwelling in Baitheneth, and Israel dwelt in the midst of the Canaanite dwelling in the land; but those dwelling in Baithsamys and Baitheneth became tribute for them.

34 And the Amorite pressed the sons of Dan into the mountain, because he did not allow him to go down into the valley.

35 And the Amorite began to dwell on the mountain of Myrsinon, where the bears and the foxes are; and the hand of the house of Joseph was heavy upon the Amorite, and he became tribute.

36 And the boundary of the Amorite was the Idumaean above Akrabin at the Rock and above.

Chapter 2

1 And an angel of the Lord went up from Galgal to Klauchmon and to Bethel and to the house of Israel and said to them: The Lord, the Lord, brought you up from Egypt and brought you into the land which he swore to your fathers to give you, and said to you: I will not scatter my covenant with you forever;

2 and you shall not make a covenant with those settled in this land, nor shall you bow down to their gods, but you shall shatter their carved images and tear down their altars. And you did not listen to my voice when you did these things.

3 And I said: I will no longer continue to remove the people whom I said I would destroy from before you, and they will be constraints for you, and their gods will be a stumbling block for you.

4 And it happened when the angel of the Lord spoke these words to all Israel that the people raised their voice and wept.

5 Therefore the name of that place was called Weeping; and they sacrificed there to the Lord.

6 And Jesus sent the people away, and the sons of Israel departed, each to his house and to his inheritance to inherit the land.

7 And the people served the Lord all the days of Jesus and all the days of the elders who lived long after Jesus, who knew all the great work of the Lord which he did for Israel.

8 And Jesus son of Naue, servant of the Lord, died at one hundred and ten years of age.

9 And they buried him within the boundary of his inheritance in Thamnathares in Mount Ephraim to the north of Mount Gaas.

10 And all that generation were added to their fathers, and another generation arose after them who did not know the Lord and the work which he did for Israel.

11 And the sons of Israel did what was evil before the Lord and served the Baalim.

12 And they abandoned the Lord God of their fathers who brought them out of the land of Egypt and went after other gods from the gods of the peoples around them and bowed down to them and provoked the Lord to anger,

13 and they abandoned the Lord and served Baal and the Astartes.

14 And the Lord was angry with Israel in wrath and delivered them into the hand of plunderers, and they plundered them; and he sold them into the hand of their enemies round about, and they were unable to stand before their enemies.

15 In all the things in which they committed harlotry, the hand of the Lord was against them for evils, as the Lord had spoken and as the Lord had sworn, and he pressed them very hard.

16 And the Lord raised up judges for them and saved them from the hand of those plundering them.

17 And even their judges they did not listen to, because they went whoring after other gods and bowed down to them and provoked the Lord to anger; and they turned aside quickly from the way in which their fathers walked to obey the commandments of the Lord; they did not do thus.

18 And because the Lord raised up judges for them, the Lord was with the judge and saved them from the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge, because the Lord was moved by their groaning before those besieging them and afflicting them.

19 And it happened when the judge died that they turned back and again acted more corruptly than their fathers, going after other gods to serve them and bow down to them; they did not cast aside their practices and did not depart from their hard way.

20 And the Lord was angry in wrath with Israel and said: Because this nation abandoned my covenant which I commanded their fathers and did not obey my voice,

21 I too will no longer continue to remove a man from before them from the nations which Jesus left and allowed to remain,

22 to test Israel by them, whether they keep the way of the Lord to walk in it as their fathers kept it, or not.

23 And the Lord allowed these nations to remain, not removing them quickly, and did not deliver them into the hand of Jesus.

Chapter 3

1 And these are the nations Jesus allowed to remain in order to test Israel by them, all those who had not known all the wars of Canaan,

2 except on account of the generations of the sons of Israel to teach them war, except that those before them had not known them;

3 the five satrapies of the foreigners and all the Canaanite and the Sidonian and the Euaite dwelling in Lebanon from Mount Balaermon as far as Lobohamath.

4 And it happened so as to test Israel by them, to know whether they would listen to the commandments of the Lord which he commanded their fathers by the hand of Moses.

5 And the sons of Israel dwelt among the Canaanite and the Chettite and the Amorite and the Pherezite and the Euaite and the Iebusite,

6 and took their daughters for themselves as wives and gave their daughters to their sons and served their gods.

7 And the sons of Israel did evil before the Lord and forgot the Lord their God and served the Baalim and the groves.

8 And the Lord was angry in wrath with Israel and sold them into the hands of Chousarsathom king of Syria of the Rivers, and they served him eight years.

9 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord; and the Lord raised up a savior for Israel and saved them, Gothoniel son of Kenez, the younger brother of Chaleb, and he listened to him.

10 And the spirit of the Lord came upon him, and he judged Israel and went out to war; and the Lord delivered Chousarsathom king of Syria into his hand, and his hand became strong against Chousarsathom.

11 And the land was quiet fifty years; and Gothoniel son of Kenez died.

12 And the sons of Israel again did evil before the Lord. And the Lord strengthened Eglom king of Moab against Israel because they had done evil before the Lord.

13 And he brought to him all the sons of Ammon and Amalek, and he went and struck Israel and inherited the city of palms.

14 And the sons of Israel served Eglom king of Moab eighteen years.

15 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord; and the Lord raised up for them a savior, Aod son of Gera son of the Iemeni, a man right-handed on both sides. And the sons of Israel sent gifts by his hand to Eglom king of Moab.

16 And Aod made for himself a double-edged knife, a span in length, and girded it under his cloak on his right thigh.

17 And he brought the gifts to Eglom king of Moab; and Eglom was a very handsome man.

18 And it happened when Aod finished bringing the gifts that he sent away those carrying the gifts.

19 And Eglom turned back from the carved images near Galgal, and Aod said: I have a secret word for you, king. And Eglom said to all: Out from the midst; and all those standing by him went out from him.

20 And Aod entered to him, and he was sitting in his summer upper room, utterly alone. And Aod said: I have a word of God for you, king; and Eglom rose from the throne near him.

21 And it happened as he rose that Aod stretched out his left hand and took the knife from his right thigh and thrust it into Eglom's belly,

22 and he brought in even the handle behind the blade, and the fat closed over the blade, because he did not pull the knife out of his belly.

23 And Aod went out into the porch and closed the doors of the upper room upon him and wedged them shut;

24 and he went out. And his servants entered and saw, and behold, the doors of the upper room were shut, and they said: Perhaps he is sitting at stools in the withdrawal of the bedchamber?

25 And they waited until they were ashamed, and behold, there was no one opening the doors of the upper room; and they took the key and opened, and behold, their lord lay fallen upon the ground, dead.

26 And Aod escaped while they were disturbed, and there was no one attending to him; and he passed the carved images and escaped to Seirotha.

27 And it happened when he came that he sounded a horn on Mount Ephraim; and the sons of Israel went down with him, and he before them.

28 And he said to them: Go down after me, because the Lord God has delivered your enemies, Moab, into your hand. And they went down after him and seized ahead of time the crossings of the Jordan of Moab and did not allow a man to cross.

29 And they struck Moab at that time, about ten thousand men, all the fighters among them and every man of strength, and not a man escaped.

30 And Moab was put to shame on that day under the hand of Israel, and the land was quiet eighty years, and Aod judged them until he died.

31 And after him Samegar son of Anath arose and struck the foreigners, six hundred men apart from calves of the cattle; and he saved Israel.

Chapter 4

1 And the sons of Israel again did evil before the Lord.

2 And the Lord sold them into the hand of Iabin king of Canaan, who reigned in Asor; and the ruler of his force was Sisara, and he dwelt in Arisoth of the nations.

3 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord, because he had nine hundred iron chariots, and he pressed Israel forcefully for twenty years.

4 And Debbora, a woman prophet, the wife of Laphidoth, she judged Israel at that time.

5 And she sat under the palm of Debbora between Rama and Bethel in Mount Ephraim, and the sons of Israel went up to her there to be judged.

6 And Debbora sent and called Barak son of Abineem from Kedes of Nephthali and said to him: Did not the Lord the God of Israel command you, and you shall go to Mount Thabor and take with yourself ten thousand men from the sons of Nephthali and from the sons of Zabulon?

7 And I will lead to you at the torrent Kison Sisara, ruler of Iabin's force, and his chariots and his multitude, and I will deliver him into your hand.

8 And Barak said to her: If you go with me, I will go, and if you do not go with me, I will not go; for I do not know the day on which the Lord prospers the angel with me.

9 And Debbora said to him: Going, I will go with you; only know that your precedence will not be in the way on which you go, because the Lord will deliver Sisara into the hand of a woman. And Debbora arose and went with Barak to Kedes.

10 And Barak gave orders to Zabulon and Nephthali at Kedes, and ten thousand men went up at his heels; and Debbora went up with him.

11 And the neighbors of the Kenite separated from the sons of Iobab, father-in-law of Moses, and he pitched his tent by the oak of those resting, which is next to Kedes.

12 And they reported to Sisara that Barak son of Abineem had gone up onto Mount Thabor.

13 And Sisara summoned all his chariots [for he had nine hundred iron chariots] and all the people with him from Arisoth of the nations to the torrent Kison.

14 And Debbora said to Barak: Arise, for this is the day on which the Lord has delivered Sisara into your hand; behold, will not the Lord go before you? And Barak went down from Mount Thabor and ten thousand men after him.

15 And the Lord threw Sisara and all his chariots and all his camp into confusion by the edge of the sword before Barak; and Sisara got down from his chariot and fled on his feet.

16 And Barak pursued after the chariots and after the camp as far as the forest of the nations; and all the camp of Sisara fell by the edge of the sword; not one was left.

17 And Sisara withdrew on his feet to the tent of Iael wife of Chaber the Kenite, because there was peace between Iabin king of Asor and the house of Chaber the Kenite.

18 And Iael went out to meet Sisara and said to him: Turn aside, my lord, turn aside to me, do not fear; and he turned aside to her into the tent, and she covered him with her hide covering.

19 And Sisara said to her: Give me, please, a little water to drink, for I am thirsty; and she opened the skin of milk and gave him drink and covered his face.

20 And he said to her: Stand at the door of the tent, and it will be that if someone comes to you and asks you and says to you, Is there a man here? you shall say, There is not; and she covered him with her hide covering.

21 And Iael wife of Chaber took the tent peg and placed the hammer in her hand and came in to him quietly and drove the peg into his jaw and drove it through into the ground, and he twitched between her knees and expired and died.

22 And behold, Barak was pursuing Sisara, and Iael went out to meet him and said to him: Come and I will show you the man whom you seek. And he entered to her, and behold, Sisara lay dead, and the peg was in his jaw.

23 And the Lord God humbled Iabin king of Canaan on that day before the sons of Israel.

24 And the hand of the sons of Israel went on, going and growing hard against Iabin king of Canaan, until they destroyed him.

Chapter 5

1 And Debbora and Barak son of Abineem sang on that day and said:

2 When leaders began to lead in Israel, when the people chose, bless the Lord.

3 Hear, kings; give ear, mighty satraps; I will sing to the Lord, I will make music to the God of Israel.

4 Lord, at your going out from Seir, at your departing from the field of Edom, the earth shook, and heaven was astonished, and the clouds dripped water;

5 mountains were shaken before the Lord, this Sinai before the Lord God of Israel.

6 In the days of Samegar son of Anath, in the days of Iael, kings failed and they traveled paths, they traveled twisted roads.

7 One speaking failed in Israel, failed, until Debbora arose, because a mother arose in Israel.

8 They chose new gods as barley bread; a covering, if I see, of siromastai among forty thousands.

9 My heart is upon those appointed for Israel; mighty ones of the people, bless the Lord.

10 Those mounted on beasts of burden, those seated upon covered carriages,

11 utter a voice of those playing among those rejoicing; there they will give righteousness to the Lord. Righteous ones grew strong in Israel; then the people of the Lord went down to their cities.

12 Awake, awake, Debbora, awaken myriads with the people, awake, awake, speak with song; being strong arise, Barak, and strengthen Barak, Debbora; take captive your captivity, son of Abineem.

13 When was his strength magnified? Lord, humble for me those stronger than I.

14 The people of Ephraim took vengeance on them in the valley of your brother Benjamin among your peoples. From me Machir those searching went down, and from Zabulon the Lord fought for me among the mighty, from there with a scepter of one strengthening leadership.

15 Among Issachar with Debbora he sent his foot soldiers into the valley. Why do you dwell in the midst of lips? He stretched out at his feet. Among the divisions of Rouben were great examinations of heart.

16 Why do you sit for me among the mosphathaim to listen to the whistles of those awakening? To pass into the things of Rouben were great tracings of heart.

17 Galaad encamped beyond the Jordan; and Dan, why does he sojourn among ships? Aser sojourned by the shore of seas and encamped at his openings.

18 Zabulon, a people who reproached his soul unto death, and Nephthali upon the heights of the field.

19 Kings came and drew up for battle. Then kings of Canaan fought at Thennach by the water of Mageddo; they took no gain of silver.

20 From heaven the stars fought, from their array they fought with Sisara.

21 The torrent Kison cast them out, the torrent kademim, the torrent Kison; my strong soul will trample them.

22 Then the heels of a horse were cut off, amadaroth of his mighty ones.

23 Curse Maroz, said the angel of the Lord, curse with a curse its inhabitants, because they did not come to the help of the Lord; our helper is the Lord, mighty among fighters.

24 May Iael wife of Chaber the Kenite be blessed among women, among women in a tent may she be blessed.

25 He asked her for water, and she gave him milk; in a bowl of mighty ones she brought butter near.

26 She stretched out her left hand to a peg, her right to cuttings of those who strike, and she cut Sisara, rubbed away his head and crushed and drove through his jaw.

27 Between her feet, bending down, he fell, he lay down between her feet; where he bent down, there he fell, wretched.

28 Through the little window the mother of Sisara peered, looking through the lattice at those returning with Sisara: Why was his chariot so late in arriving? Why were the tracks of his chariots delayed?

29 Wise women among her rulers answered her, and she answered with her own words:

30 Will they not find him dividing spoils? Being friendly with friends for the head of a mighty one; spoils of dyed things for Sisara, spoils of dyed things of varied work, a dye of varied things around his neck as spoil.

31 Thus may all your enemies perish, Lord; and those who love him, like the rising of the sun in his powers. And the land was quiet forty years.

Chapter 6

1 And the sons of Israel did evil before the Lord, and the Lord delivered them into the hand of Madiam for seven years.

2 And the hand of Madiam prevailed over Israel; and the sons of Israel made for themselves, because of Madiam, enclosures in the mountains and the caves and the strongholds.

3 And it happened whenever a man of Israel sowed that Madiam and Amalek and the sons of the east went up against him;

4 and they encamped against them and destroyed the produce of the land as far as Gaza, and they left no subsistence of life in Israel, nor flock nor calf nor donkey;

5 because they and their cattle went up and carried their tents along and arrived in number like locusts, and neither they nor their camels had a number, and they arrived in the land of Israel to destroy it.

6 And Israel became very poor because of Madiam, and the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord.

7 And it happened when the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord because of Madiam

8 that the Lord sent a man, a prophet, to the sons of Israel, and he said to them: Thus says the Lord the God of Israel: I am the one who brought you up from Egypt, and I brought you out of a house of slavery

9 and rescued you from the hand of Egypt and from the hand of all those oppressing you and drove them out from before you and gave you their land,

10 and I said to you: I am the Lord your God; you shall not fear the gods of the Amorite among whom you dwell in their land. And you did not listen to my voice.

11 And an angel of the Lord came and sat under the oak that was in Ephratha belonging to Ioas father of Abiezri, and Gedeon his son was beating wheat with a rod in a winepress to escape from Madiam.

12 And an angel of the Lord appeared to him and said to him: The Lord is with you, mighty in strength.

13 And Gedeon said to him: In me, lord, and if the Lord is with us, why have all these evils found us? And where are all his wonders which our fathers recounted to us, saying: Did not the Lord bring us up from Egypt? And now he has cast us off and delivered us into the hand of Madiam.

14 And the angel of the Lord looked upon him and said to him: Go in your strength and you will save Israel, and behold, I have sent you.

15 And Gedeon said to him: In me, lord, by what shall I save Israel? Behold, my thousand is the lowest in Manasse, and I am small in my father's house.

16 And the angel of the Lord said to him: The Lord will be with you, and you will strike Madiam as one man.

17 And Gedeon said to him: And if I have found favor in your eyes, you will make for me a sign that you are speaking with me;

18 do not move from here until I come to you, and I will bring my sacrifice and place it before you. And he said: I am; I will sit until you return.

19 And Gedeon entered and made a kid of the goats and unleavened bread from an oiphi of flour, and placed the meat upon the basket and poured the broth into a pot and brought it out to him under the oak and bowed down.

20 And the angel of the Lord said to him: Take the meat and the unleavened loaves and put them by that rock and pour out the broth; and he did so.

21 And the angel of the Lord stretched out the end of the staff in his hand and touched the meat and the unleavened bread, and fire was kindled from the rock and devoured the meat and the unleavened bread; and the angel of the Lord departed from his sight.

22 And Gedeon saw that it was an angel of the Lord, and Gedeon said: Ah, ah, Lord, Lord, for I saw the angel of the Lord face to face.

23 And the Lord said to him: Peace to you; do not fear, do not die.

24 And Gedeon built an altar there to the Lord and called it Peace of the Lord; to this day it is still in Ephratha of the father of Ezri.

25 And it happened that night that the Lord said to him: Take your father's fattened calf, a seven-year-old calf, and pull down the altar of Baal which belongs to your father and cut down the grove upon it;

26 and you shall build an altar to the Lord your God who appeared to you upon the summit of this Mount Maoz in the array, and take the calf and offer a whole burnt offering with the wood of the grove which you will cut down.

27 And Gedeon took thirteen men from his servants and did as the Lord spoke to him; and it happened that because he feared his father's house and the men of the city to do it by day, he did it by night.

28 And the men of the city rose early in the morning, and behold, the altar of Baal had been torn down and the grove upon it had been cut down and the fattened calf had been offered as a whole burnt offering on the altar that had been built.

29 And each man said to his neighbor: Who did this thing? And they examined and searched and said: Gedeon son of Ioas did this thing.

30 And the men of the city said to Ioas: Bring out your son and let him die, because he tore down the altar of Baal and cut down the grove upon it.

31 And Ioas said to the men standing against him: Are you now pleading a case for Baal? Or are you saving him? Whoever contended against him will die by morning; if he is a god, he himself will vindicate himself because he tore down his altar.

32 And he called it on that day Tribunal of Baal, because he tore down his altar.

33 And all Madiam and Amalek and the sons of the east gathered together and crossed over and encamped in the valley of Iezrael.

34 And a spirit of God clothed Gedeon, and he sounded a horn, and Abiezer cried out after him.

35 And he sent messengers throughout Manasse, and he too cried out after him; and he sent messengers in Aser and in Zabulon and in Nephthali, and they went up to meet him.

36 And Gedeon said to God: If you are saving Israel by my hand, in the manner you spoke,

37 behold, I am placing a fleece of wool on the threshing floor, and if dew comes upon the fleece alone and dryness upon all the land, then I will know that you are saving Israel by my hand, in the manner you spoke.

38 And it happened thus; and Gedeon rose early the next day and squeezed the fleece, and dew flowed out from the fleece, a full basin of water.

39 And Gedeon said to God: Let your wrath not be angry with me, and I will speak once more; and I will test once more with the fleece, and let there be dryness upon the fleece alone, but upon all the land let there be dew.

40 And God did thus on that night, and there was dryness upon the fleece alone, but upon all the land there was dew.

Chapter 7

1 And Ierobaal [he is Gedeon] and all the people with him rose early and encamped upon the land of Aroed, and the camp of Madiam and Amalek was north of him from the hill of Abor in the valley.

2 And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people with you are too many for me to deliver Madiam into their hand, lest Israel boast against me, saying: My hand saved me.

3 And the Lord said to him: Speak, then, in the ears of the people, saying: Who is timid and afraid? Let him turn back. And they set out from Mount Galaad and twenty-two thousand turned back from the people, and ten thousand remained.

4 And the Lord said to Gedeon: The people are still many; bring them down to the water, and I will test them for you there; and it will be that whomever I say to you, This one will go with you, he will go with you; and whomever I say to you that he will not go with you, he will not go with you.

5 And he brought the people down to the water; and the Lord said to Gedeon: Everyone who laps with his tongue from the water as the dog laps, you shall stand him alone, and everyone who bends upon his knees to drink, you shall set him apart by himself.

6 And the whole number of those who lapped with their tongue was three hundred men, and all the rest of the people bent upon their knees to drink water.

7 And the Lord said to Gedeon: By the three hundred men who lapped I will save you and deliver Madiam into your hand, and let all the people run back, each man to his place.

8 And they took the people's provisions in their hand and their horns, and he sent every man of Israel to his dwelling, each man, but retained the three hundred men. And the camp of Madiam was below him in the valley.

9 And it happened on that night that the Lord said to him: Arise, go down quickly from here into the camp, for I have delivered it into your hand;

10 but if you fear to go down, go down, you and Phara your young servant, into the camp

11 and you will hear what they are saying; and after these things your hands will be strong, and you will go down into the camp. And he and Phara his young servant went down to a part of the fifty in the camp.

12 And Madiam and Amalek and all the sons of the east had encamped in the valley, numerous as locusts, and their camels had no number, but were as the sand upon the shore of the sea in multitude.

13 And Gedeon entered, and behold, a man was recounting a dream to his neighbor and said: Behold the dream I dreamed: a cake of barley bread was rolling in the camp of Madiam and came as far as the tent of Madiam and struck it and overturned it, and the tent fell.

14 And his neighbor answered and said: This is nothing other than the sword of Gedeon son of Ioas, a man of Israel; the Lord has delivered Madiam and all the camp into his hand.

15 And it happened when Gedeon heard the recounting of the dream and its interpretation that he bowed down to the Lord and returned to the camp of Israel and said: Arise, for the Lord has delivered the camp of Madiam into your hands.

16 And he divided the three hundred men into three groups and gave horns into the hands of all and empty jars and torches in the midst of the jars

17 and said to them: Watch me and do likewise; and behold, I am entering into the midst of the camp, and it will be that as I do, so you shall do;

18 and I and all those with me will sound the horn, and you too shall sound the horns around the camp and say: For the Lord and for Gedeon.

19 And Gedeon and a hundred men with him entered a part of the camp as the middle watch began; but he woke the guards with a waking, and they sounded the horns and shook out the jars in their hands.

20 And the three groups sounded the horns and broke the jars and took the torches in their left hand, and in their right hand the horns to sound, and cried out: A sword for the Lord and for Gedeon.

21 And each stood by himself around the camp, and all the camp ran and sounded a signal and fled.

22 And the three hundred horns sounded, and the Lord set each man's sword against his neighbor throughout the camp, and the camp fled as far as Baithasetta and gathered as far as the edge of Abelmeoula and toward Tabath.

23 And a man of Israel cried out from Nephthali and from Aser and from all Manasse, and they pursued after Madiam.

24 And Gedeon sent messengers throughout the boundary of Ephraim, saying: Go down to meet Madiam and seize for yourselves the water as far as Baithbera and the Jordan; and every man of Ephraim cried out and they seized the water ahead of them as far as Baithbera and the Jordan.

25 And they captured the two rulers of Madiam, Oreb and Zeb, and killed Oreb at Sourin and killed Zeb at Iakephzeb and pursued Madiam; and they brought the heads of Oreb and Zeb to Gedeon from beyond the Jordan.

Chapter 8

1 And a man of Ephraim said to him: What is this thing you have done to us by not calling us when you went out to fight against Madiam? And they disputed strongly with him.

2 And he said to them: What have I done now like you? Are not the gleanings of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer?

3 Into your hands the Lord delivered the rulers of Madiam, Oreb and Zeb; and what was I able to do like you? And they ceased. Then their spirit relaxed from him when he spoke this word.

4 And Gedeon came to the Jordan, and he and the three hundred men with him crossed, fainthearted and hungry.

5 And he said to the men of Sokchoth: Give, please, loaves to the people with me, because they are hungry, and I am pursuing Zebee and Salmana, kings of Madiam.

6 And the rulers of Sokchoth said: Is the hand of Zebee and Salmana now in your hand, that we should give loaves to your army?

7 And Gedeon said: Not so; when the Lord gives Zebee and Salmana into my hand, I will card your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with the barkonnim.

8 And he went up from there to Phanouel and spoke to them in the same way, and the men of Phanouel answered him in the manner the men of Sokchoth answered him.

9 And he said to the men of Phanouel: When I return in peace I will tear down this tower. –

10 And Zebee and Salmana were in Karkar, and their camp with them, about fifteen thousand, those left in all the camp of the sons of the east, and those who had fallen were one hundred and twenty thousand men who drew the sword.

11 And Gedeon went up by the way of those dwelling in tents east of Nabeth opposite Zebee; and he struck the camp, while the camp was confident.

12 And Zebee and Salmana fled, and he pursued after them and seized the two kings of Madiam, Zebee and Salmana, and crushed all their camp. –

13 And Gedeon son of Ioas returned from the war by the ascent of Ares.

14 And they captured a young man from the men of Sokchoth, and he questioned him, and he wrote down for them the rulers of Sokchoth and its elders, seventy-seven men.

15 And Gedeon came to the rulers of Sokchoth and said to them: Behold Zebee and Salmana, on whose account you reproached me, saying: Is the hand of Zebee and Salmana now in your hand, that we should give loaves to your exhausted men?

16 And he took the rulers and the elders of the city and carded them with the thorns of the wilderness and the barakenim, and with them carded the men of Sokchoth.

17 And he tore down the tower of Phanouel and killed the men of the city. –

18 And he said to Zebee and Salmana: Where are the men whom you killed at Thabor? And they said: Like you, resembling you, resembling them, like the appearance of the form of sons of kings.

19 And Gedeon said: They are my brothers and sons of my mother. And he swore to them: As the Lord lives, if you had kept them alive, I would not have killed you.

20 And he said to Iether his firstborn: Rise and kill them; and his young son did not draw his knife, because he was afraid, because he was younger.

21 And Zebee and Salmana said: Rise, please, yourself and meet us, for as a man is, so is his strength. And Gedeon arose and killed Zebee and Salmana and took the crescents that were on the necks of their camels.

22 And a man of Israel said to Gedeon: Rule among us, you and your sons, because you saved us from the hand of Madiam.

23 And Gedeon said to them: I will not rule over you, and my son will not rule over you; the Lord will rule over you.

24 And Gedeon said to them: I will ask a request of you: Each man give me an earring from his spoils; for they had many gold earrings, because they were Ishmaelites.

25 And they said: Giving, we will give. And he spread out his cloak, and each man cast there a gold earring from his spoils.

26 And the weight of the gold earrings which he asked for was one thousand seven hundred shekels of gold, apart from the sirones and the little chains emphoth and the purple cloaks upon the kings of Madiam and apart from the gold collars on the necks of their camels.

27 And Gedeon made it into an ephoud and set it in his city in Ephratha; and all Israel went whoring after it there, and it became a stumbling block to Gedeon and his house.

28 And Madiam was put to shame before the sons of Israel and no longer raised its head. And the land was quiet forty years in the days of Gedeon. –

29 And Ierobaal son of Ioas went and dwelt in his house.

30 And Gedeon had seventy sons who came out of his thighs, for he had many wives.

31 And his concubine in Sikimois also bore him a son, and he gave him the name Abimelech.

32 And Gedeon son of Ioas died in a good old age and was buried in the tomb of Ioas his father in Ephratha of the father of Abiezri.

33 And it happened when Gedeon died that the sons of Israel turned back and went whoring after the Baalim and set Baalberith for themselves as a covenant, to be their god.

34 And the sons of Israel did not remember the Lord their God who rescued them from the hand of all their enemies round about.

35 And they did not show mercy to the house of Ierobaal Gedeon according to all the goodness which he had done with Israel.

Chapter 9

1 And Abimelech son of Ierobaal went to Sikima to his mother's brothers and spoke to them and to all the kin of his mother's house, saying:

2 Speak, please, in the ears of the men of Sikimois: Which is better, for seventy men, all the sons of Ierobaal, to rule over you, or for one man to have dominion over you? And remember that I am your flesh and your bone.

3 And his mother's brothers spoke about him in the ears of all the men of Sikimois all these words, and their heart inclined after Abimelech, because they said: He is our brother.

4 And they gave him seventy pieces of silver from the house of Baal of the Covenant, and Abimelech hired with them empty and bewildered men, and they went after him.

5 And he entered his father's house in Ephratha and killed his brothers, the sons of Ierobaal, seventy men upon one stone; and Ioatham son of Ierobaal, the youngest, remained, because he hid.

6 And all the men of Sikimois and all the house of Maallon gathered and went and made Abimelech king by the acorn of the station in Sikimois.

7 And they reported to Ioatham, and he went and stood on the summit of Mount Garizin and raised his voice and called and said to them: Hear me, men of Sikimois, and may God hear you.

8 Going, the trees went to anoint a king for themselves and said to the olive tree: Reign over us.

9 And the olive tree said to them: Having left my fatness, by which God and people were glorified in me, shall I go to rule the trees?

10 And the trees said to the fig tree: Come, reign over us.

11 And the fig tree said to them: Having left my sweetness and my good fruit, shall I go to rule over trees?

12 And the trees said to the vine: Come, reign over us.

13 And the vine said to them: Having left my wine, the gladness from the God of men, shall I go to rule trees?

14 And the trees said to the bramble: Come, you reign over us.

15 And the bramble said to the trees: If in truth you anoint me king over you, come, trust in my shade; and if not, may fire go out from the bramble and devour the cedars of Lebanon. –

16 And now, if in truth and in completeness you acted and made Abimelech king, and if you did well with Ierobaal and with his house, and if you acted toward him according to the recompense of his hand,

17 – as my father fought on your behalf and cast his soul opposite and rescued you from the hand of Madiam,

18 and you rose up against my father's house today and killed his sons, seventy men upon one stone, and made Abimelech the son of his maidservant king over the men of Sikimois because he is your brother, –

19 and if in truth and completeness you acted with Ierobaal and his house on this day, may you be blessed and rejoice in Abimelech, and may he also rejoice in you.

20 And if not, may fire go out from Abimelech and devour the men of Sikimois and the house of Maallon; and if not, may fire go out from the men of Sikimois and from the house of Maallon and devour Abimelech. –

21 And Ioatham ran away and went on the road and fled to Rara and dwelt there because of Abimelech his brother.

22 And Abimelech ruled over Israel three years.

23 And God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Sikimois, and the men of Sikimois acted treacherously in the house of Abimelech,

24 to bring the injustice against the seventy sons of Ierobaal and to place their blood upon Abimelech their brother who killed them and upon the men of Sikimois who strengthened his hands to kill his brothers.

25 And the men of Sikimois placed an ambush for him on the tops of the mountains and seized all who passed by them on the road; and it was reported to Abimelech.

26 And Gaal son of Abed and his brothers came to Sikima, and the men of Sikimois trusted in him.

27 And they went into the field and harvested their vineyards and trod them and made dances and entered the house of their god and ate and drank and cursed Abimelech.

28 And Gaal son of Abed said: What is Abimelech, and who is the son of Sychem, that we should serve him? Is this one not a son of Ierobaal, and Zeboul his overseer his servant with the men of Emmor father of Sychem? And why should we serve him?

29 And who would give this people into my hand? And I would remove Abimelech and say to Abimelech: Multiply your force and come out.

30 And Zeboul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal son of Abed and was angry with wrath.

31 And he sent messengers to Abimelech with gifts, saying: Behold, Gaal son of Abed and his brothers have come to Sikima, and these are besieging the city against you;

32 and now arise by night, you and the people with you, and lie in ambush in the field,

33 and it will be in the morning, as the sun rises, that you will rise early and stretch out against the city, and behold, he and the people with him will come out toward you, and you shall do to him as your hand finds.

34 And Abimelech and all the people with him arose by night and lay in ambush against Sikima in four groups.

35 And morning came, and Gaal son of Abed went out and stood by the door of the gate of the city, and Abimelech and the people with him arose from the ambushes.

36 And Gaal son of Abed saw the people and said to Zeboul: Behold, people coming down from the tops of the mountains. And Zeboul said to him: You see the shadow of the mountains as men.

37 And Gaal continued to speak and said: Behold, people coming down toward the sea from beside the navel of the land, and one group is arriving from the way of the oak of those looking out.

38 And Zeboul said to him: Where now is your mouth that said, Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him? Are these not the people whom you despised? Go out now and fight against him.

39 And Gaal went out before the men of Sikimois and fought against Abimelech.

40 And Abimelech pursued him, and he fled from before him; and many wounded fell as far as the doors of the city.

41 And Abimelech sat in Arima; and Zeboul drove out Gaal and his brothers so that they would not dwell in Sikimois.

42 And it happened the next day that the people went out into the plain, and it was reported to Abimelech.

43 And he took the people and divided them into three groups and lay in ambush in it; and he saw, and behold, people came out of the city, and he rose against them and struck them.

44 And Abimelech and the groups with him spread out and stood by the gate of the city, and the two groups poured out upon all those in the field, and he struck them.

45 And Abimelech fought in the city all that day, and they took the city, and he killed the people in it and pulled down the city and sowed it with salt.

46 And all the men of the tower of Sikimois heard and entered the stronghold of the house of Baal of the Covenant.

47 And it was reported to Abimelech that all the men of the tower of Sikimois had gathered.

48 And Abimelech went up to Mount Selmon, he and all the people with him, and Abimelech took an ax in his hand and cut a load of wood and took it and put it on his shoulders and said to the people with him: What you have seen me doing, quickly do as I also do.

49 And they too each cut a load and lifted it and went after Abimelech and put it against the stronghold and burned the stronghold over them with fire, and all the men of the tower of Sikimois died, about a thousand men and women.

50 And Abimelech went to Thebes and encamped around it and took it first.

51 And there was a strong tower in the middle of the city, and all the men and women and all the leaders of the city fled there and shut themselves in and went up onto the roof of the tower.

52 And Abimelech came as far as the tower, and they fought against him; and Abimelech drew near to the door of the tower to burn it with fire.

53 And one woman threw a fragment of a millstone upon Abimelech's head and crushed his skull.

54 And he cried out quickly to the young man carrying his equipment and said to him: Draw your knife and put me to death, lest they say, A woman killed him. And his young man pierced him through, and Abimelech died.

55 And a man of Israel saw that Abimelech had died, and each man went to his place.

56 And God turned back upon Abimelech the evil which he did to his father by killing his seventy brothers.

57 And all the evil of the men of Sikimois God turned back upon their head, and the curse of Ioatham son of Ierobaal came upon them.

Chapter 10

1 And after Abimelech, Thola son of Phoua, son of his father's brother, a man of Issachar, arose to save Israel, and he dwelt in Samaria in Mount Ephraim.

2 And he judged Israel twenty-three years and died and was buried in Samaria.

3 And after him Iair the Galaadite arose and judged Israel twenty-two years.

4 And he had thirty-two sons mounted on thirty-two colts; and they had thirty-two cities, and he called them the Settlements of Iair until this day, which are in the land of Galaad.

5 And Iair died and was buried in Rammo.

6 And the sons of Israel again did evil before the Lord and served the Baalim and the Astaroth and the gods of Sidon and the gods of Moab and the gods of the sons of Ammon and the gods of the foreigners and abandoned the Lord and did not serve him.

7 And the Lord became angry in wrath with Israel and sold them into the hand of foreigners and into the hand of the sons of Ammon.

8 And they broke down and crushed the sons of Israel in that year, eighteen years, all the sons of Israel beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorite in Galaaditis.

9 And the sons of Ammon crossed the Jordan to wage war also in Judah and Benjamin and in the house of Ephraim, and the sons of Israel were pressed very hard.

10 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord, saying: We have sinned against you, because we abandoned our God and served the Baalim.

11 And the Lord said to the sons of Israel: Did not the Egyptians and the Amorites and the sons of Ammon and Moab and the foreigners

12 and Sidonians and Madiam and Amalek press you? And you cried out to me, and I saved you from their hand.

13 And you abandoned me and served other gods; therefore I will no longer continue to save you.

14 Go and cry out to the gods whom you chose for yourselves, and let them save you in the time of your affliction.

15 And the sons of Israel said to the Lord: We have sinned; do to us according to all that is pleasing before you, only, Lord, rescue us on this day.

16 And they removed the foreign gods from among them and served the Lord; and he was not well pleased among the people, and he grew fainthearted in the toil of Israel.

17 And the sons of Ammon went up and encamped in Galaad, and the sons of Israel went out and encamped in Massepha.

18 And the rulers of the people of Galaad said, each man to his neighbor: Who is the man who will begin to fight against the sons of Ammon? He shall be head of all those dwelling in Galaad.

Chapter 11

1 And Iephthae the Galaadite was mighty in strength; and he was the son of a prostitute, and she bore Iephthae to Galaad.

2 And the wife of Galaad bore him sons; and the sons of the wife grew strong and drove out Iephthae and said to him: You shall not inherit in our father's house, because you are the son of a courtesan.

3 And Iephthae fled from before his brothers and dwelt in the land of Tob, and plain men gathered to Iephthae and went out with him.

4 And it happened after days that the sons of Ammon fought with Israel.

5 And it happened when the sons of Ammon fought with Israel that the elders of Galaad went to take Iephthae from the land of Tob

6 and said to Iephthae: Come and be our leader, and let us fight against the sons of Ammon.

7 And Iephthae said to the elders of Galaad: Did you not hate me and drive me out of my father's house and send me away from you? And why have you come to me when you are afflicted?

8 And the elders of Galaad said to Iephthae: Not so; now we have come to you, and you will go with us, and we will fight against the sons of Ammon; and you will be head for us, for all those dwelling in Galaad.

9 And Iephthae said to the elders of Galaad: If you bring me back to fight against the sons of Ammon and the Lord delivers them before me, I will be your head.

10 And the elders of Galaad said to Iephthae: The Lord will be the one who hears between us if we do not act thus according to your word.

11 And Iephthae went with the elders of Galaad, and they appointed him over them as head and leader. And Iephthae spoke all his words before the Lord in Massepha.

12 And Iephthae sent messengers to the king of the sons of Ammon, saying: What is there between me and you, that you have come to me to fight me in my land?

13 And the king of the sons of Ammon said to the messengers of Iephthae: Because Israel took my land when he came up from Egypt, from Arnon as far as Iabok and as far as the Jordan; and now return those lands in peace.

14 And the messengers returned to Iephthae. And Iephthae sent messengers to the king of the sons of Ammon

15 saying: Thus says Iephthae: Israel did not take the land of Moab or the land of the sons of Ammon

16 when they came up from Egypt, but Israel went in the wilderness as far as the Red Sea and came as far as Kades.

17 And Israel sent messengers to the king of Edom, saying: I will pass through your land; and the king of Edom did not listen. And he also sent to the king of Moab, and he was unwilling. And Israel sat in Kades.

18 And he passed through the wilderness and went around the land of Edom and the land of Moab and came to the east of the land of Moab and encamped beyond Arnon and did not enter the boundary of Moab, because Arnon was the boundary of Moab.

19 And Israel sent messengers to Seon king of Esebon, the Amorite, and Israel said to him: I will pass through your land as far as my place.

20 And Seon was unwilling to let Israel pass through his boundaries; and Seon gathered all his people and encamped at Iassa and fought with Israel.

21 And the Lord the God of Israel delivered Seon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and he struck them; and Israel inherited all the land of the Amorite dwelling in the land.

22 And he inherited all the boundary of the Amorite from Arnon as far as Iabok and from the wilderness as far as the Jordan.

23 And now the Lord the God of Israel removed the Amorite from before his people Israel, and will you inherit him for yourself?

24 Will you not inherit whatever Chamos your god allotted you to inherit? And everything that the Lord our God allotted us to inherit from before us, we will inherit.

25 And now are you any better than Balak son of Sepphor, king of Moab? Did he contend in a contest with Israel or fight them in war?

26 While the house of Israel was in Esebon and its daughter towns and in Iazer and its daughter towns and in all the cities beside the Jordan for three hundred years, why did they not rescue them in that time?

27 And I have not sinned against you, but you are doing evil with me by fighting against me; may the Lord, the one who judges, judge today between the sons of Israel and the sons of Ammon.

28 And the king of the sons of Ammon did not listen and did not listen to the words of Iephthae which he sent to him.

29 And the spirit of the Lord came upon Iephthae, and he passed through the land of Galaad and Manasse and passed through the lookout of Galaad and from the lookout of Galaad to the other side of the sons of Ammon.

30 And Iephthae vowed a vow to the Lord and said: If you indeed deliver the sons of Ammon into my hand,

31 then whoever comes out from the doors of my house to meet me when I return in peace from the sons of Ammon shall be for the Lord, and I will offer him up as a whole burnt offering.

32 And Iephthae crossed over to the sons of Ammon to fight against them, and the Lord delivered them into his hand.

33 And he struck them from Aroer as far as coming to Semoith, twenty cities as far as Abel of the vineyards, a very great blow, and the sons of Ammon were put to shame before the sons of Israel.

34 And Iephthae came to Massepha to his house, and behold, his daughter came out to meet him with drums and dances; and she was his only beloved child, and he had no son or daughter besides her.

35 And it happened when he saw her that he tore his garments and said: Woe is me, my daughter, you have impeded me, you became a thorn in my eyes, and I opened my mouth concerning you to the Lord and will not be able to turn back.

36 And she said to him: My father, if you opened your mouth to the Lord concerning me, do to me in the manner that came out of your mouth, since the Lord has made vengeance for you upon your enemies, the sons of Ammon.

37 And she said to her father: And do this thing for me: Let me be for two months, and I will go and descend upon the mountains and weep over my virginity, I and my companions.

38 And he said: Go; and he sent her away for two months. And she went, she and her companions, and wept over her virginity on the mountains.

39 And it happened after the end of two months that she returned to her father, and Iephthae fulfilled his vow which he had vowed; and she had not known a man. And it became an ordinance in Israel;

40 from days to days the daughters of Israel went together to lament the daughter of Iephthae the Galaadite four days in the year.

Chapter 12

1 And the sons of Ephraim gathered and came to Sephina and said to Iephthae: Why did you go to fight against the sons of Ammon and not call us to go with you? We will burn your house with fire.

2 And Iephthae said to them: I and my people were a man in dispute, and the sons of Ammon humbled me greatly; and I cried out to you, and you did not save me from their hand.

3 And I saw that there was no one saving, and I placed my soul in my hand and crossed over to the sons of Ammon, and the Lord delivered them into my hand; and why have you come up to me today to fight against me?

4 And Iephthae gathered all the men of Galaad and fought Ephraim, and the men of Galaad struck Ephraim, because they said: You are those who have escaped from Ephraim, Galaad in the midst of Ephraim and in the midst of Manasse.

5 And the men of Galaad seized ahead of time the crossings of the Jordan belonging to Ephraim, and it happened that those who had escaped from Ephraim said, Let us cross, and the men of Galaad said to them: Are you from Ephraim? And they said: We are not.

6 And they said to them: Say, please, Password; and they could not manage to speak thus. And they seized them and slaughtered them at the crossings of the Jordan, and forty-two thousand from Ephraim fell at that time.

7 And Iephthae judged Israel six years. And Iephthae the Galaadite died and was buried in his city of Galaad.

8 And after him Esebon from Bethlehem judged Israel.

9 And he had thirty sons and thirty daughters sent outside, and he brought in thirty women from outside for his sons. And he judged Israel seven years.

10 And Esebon died and was buried in Bethlehem.

11 And after him Ailon the Zabulonite judged Israel. And he judged Israel ten years.

12 And Ailon the Zabulonite died in Ailim, and they buried him in the land of Zabulon.

13 And after him Labdon son of Sellem the Phraathonite judged Israel.

14 And he had forty sons and thirty sons of his sons mounted on seventy colts. And he judged Israel eight years.

15 And Labdon son of Sellem the Phraathonite died and was buried in Phraathon in the land of Ephraim on Mount Lanak.

Chapter 13

1 And the sons of Israel again did evil before the Lord, and the Lord delivered them into the hand of the foreigners for forty years.

2 And there was a man from Saraa of the tribe of Dan, and his name was Manoe, and his wife was barren and did not bear.

3 And an angel of the Lord appeared to the woman and said to her: Behold, you are barren and have not borne; and you will conceive and bear a son.

4 And now take care and do not drink wine or strong drink and do not eat anything unclean;

5 for behold, you will conceive and bear a son, and iron shall not rise upon his head, because the child will be a consecrated Nazirite to God from the womb, and he will begin to save Israel from the hand of the foreigners.

6 And the woman came and told her husband, saying: A man of God came to me, and his appearance was like the appearance of an angel of God, very conspicuous; and I asked where he was from, and he did not tell me his name.

7 And he said to me: Behold, you will conceive and bear a son; and now do not drink wine or strong drink and do not eat any uncleanness, because the child will be a Nazirite of God from the womb until the day of his death.

8 And Manoe entreated the Lord and said: In me, Lord, let the man of God whom you sent to us come, please, to us and enlighten us as to what we should do with the child who is to be born.

9 And God listened to the voice of Manoe, and the angel of God came again to the woman while she was sitting in the field, and Manoe her husband was not with her.

10 And the woman hurried and ran out and reported to her husband and said to him: Behold, the man who came to me on that day has appeared to me.

11 And Manoe arose and went after his wife to the man and said to him: Are you the man who spoke to the woman? And the angel said: I am.

12 And Manoe said: Now, when your word comes, what will be the judgment of the child and his works?

13 And the angel of the Lord said to Manoe: Let her guard herself from all the things of which I spoke to the woman;

14 let her eat none of all that comes from the vine, and let her not drink wine or strong drink and not eat anything unclean; let her keep all that I commanded her.

15 And Manoe said to the angel of the Lord: Let us press you, please, and we will prepare a kid of the goats before you.

16 And the angel of the Lord said to Manoe: If you press me, I will not eat your bread, and if you prepare a whole burnt offering, offer it to the Lord; for Manoe did not know that he was an angel of the Lord.

17 And Manoe said to the angel of the Lord: What is your name, so that when your word comes we may glorify you?

18 And the angel of the Lord said to him: Why do you ask this, my name? And it is wonderful.

19 And Manoe took the kid of the goats and the sacrifice and offered it on the rock to the Lord, to the Lord who does wonders; and Manoe and his wife watched.

20 And it happened as the flame went up from above the altar into heaven that the angel of the Lord went up in the flame, and Manoe and his wife watched and fell upon their faces to the ground.

21 And the angel of the Lord no longer appeared to Manoe and his wife; then Manoe knew that he was an angel of the Lord.

22 And Manoe said to his wife: We shall surely die, for we have seen God.

23 And his wife said to him: If the Lord wished to put us to death, he would not have accepted from our hands a whole burnt offering and sacrifice and would not have enlightened us about all these things and would not have made these things heard by us.

24 And the woman bore a son and called his name Sampson; and the Lord blessed him, and the child grew.

25 And a spirit of the Lord began to go with him in the camp of Dan between Saraa and Esthaol.

Chapter 14

1 And Sampson went down to Thamnatha and saw a woman in Thamnatha from the daughters of the foreigners, and she was pleasing before him.

2 And he went up and reported to his father and mother and said: I have seen a woman in Thamnatha from the daughters of the foreigners, and now take her for me as a wife.

3 And his father and mother said to him: Is there no woman among the daughters of your brothers and among all my people, that you go to take a wife from the uncircumcised foreigners? And Sampson said to his father: Take this one for me, because she is pleasing in my eyes.

4 And his father and mother did not know that it was from the Lord, because he was seeking recompense from the foreigners; and at that time the foreigners ruled over the sons of Israel.

5 And Sampson and his father and mother went down to Thamnatha. And he turned aside into a vineyard of Thamnatha, and behold, a young lion roaring came to meet him;

6 and a spirit of the Lord guided itself upon him, and he tore it apart as one tears apart a kid of the goats, and there was nothing in his hand. And he did not tell his father or mother what he had done.

7 And they went down and spoke to the woman, and she was pleasing before Sampson.

8 And after days he returned to take her and turned aside to see the carcass of the lion, and behold, a cluster of bees in the mouth of the lion, and there was honey.

9 And he took it out into his mouth and went on walking and eating; and he went to his father and mother and gave them some, and they ate; and he did not tell them that he took the honey from the condition of the lion.

10 And his father went down to the woman; and Sampson made a drinking feast there for seven days, because the young men did thus.

11 And it happened when they feared him that they appointed thirty companions for him, and they were with him.

12 And Sampson said to them: I will put a riddle to you, and if you tell me the riddle within the seven days of the feast, I will give you thirty linen cloths and thirty garments;

13 and if you are unable to tell me, you will give me thirty linen cloths and thirty sets of clothing. And they said to him: Put forth your riddle, and we will hear it.

14 And he said to them: Out of the eater came food, and out of the strong came sweetness. And they were unable to tell the riddle for three days.

15 And it happened on the fourth day that they said to Sampson's wife: Deceive your husband, please, and let him tell you the riddle, lest we burn you and your father's house with fire; did you call us to become poor?

16 And Sampson's wife wept upon him and said to him: You have hated me and have not loved me, because the riddle which you put to the sons of my people you did not tell even me. And Sampson said to her: Behold, I did not tell my father or mother, and shall I tell you?

17 And she wept upon him during the seven days in which the feast was held; and it happened on the seventh day that he told her, because she troubled him; and she told the sons of her people.

18 And the men of the city said to him on the seventh day before the sun set: What is sweeter than honey, and what is stronger than a lion? And Sampson said to them: If you had not tamed my heifer, you would not have found my riddle.

19 And a spirit of the Lord guided itself upon him, and he went down to Ascalon and struck thirty men there and took their garments and gave them to those who told the riddle. And Sampson was angry in wrath and went up to his father's house.

20 And Sampson's wife lived with his bridegroom attendant, who was his companion.

Chapter 15

1 And it happened after days in the days of the wheat harvest that Sampson visited his wife carrying a kid of the goats and said: I will enter to my wife into the bedchamber; and her father did not allow him to enter to her.

2 And her father said: Saying, I said that you had utterly hated her, and I gave her to your companion; behold, is her younger sister not better than she? Let her be yours in her place.

3 And Sampson said to him: I am innocent this once of the foreigners, because I am doing evils among you.

4 And Sampson went and caught three hundred foxes and took torches and tied tail to tail and placed one torch between the two tails in the middle;

5 and he kindled fire in the torches and sent them into the sheaves of the foreigners and burned the ears of grain and what had been harvested before, from the stack as far as what was standing and as far as vineyard and olive tree.

6 And the foreigners said: Who did these things? And they said: Sampson the son-in-law of the Thamnathaite, because he took his wife and gave her to his companion; and the foreigners went up and burned the house of her father and her and her father with fire.

7 And Sampson said to them: If you do thus, I will not be satisfied, but I will take my vengeance from each and every one of you.

8 And he struck them upon the thigh with a great blow; and he went down and dwelt by the torrent in the cave of Etam.

9 And the foreigners went up and encamped against Judah and spread out in Lechi.

10 And every man of Judah said to them: Why have you come up against us? And the foreigners said: To bind Sampson and to do to him in the manner he did to us.

11 And three thousand men from Judah went down to the opening of the rock of Etam and said to Sampson: Do you not know that the foreigners rule over us, and why have you done these things to us? And Sampson said to them: As they did to us, so I did to them.

12 And they said to him: We came down to bind you and deliver you into the hands of the foreigners. And Sampson said to them: Swear to me that you yourselves will not kill me and deliver me to them, lest you yourselves meet against me.

13 And they swore to him, saying: No, but we will bind you with a bond and deliver you into their hands, but we will certainly not put you to death; and they bound him with two new cords and brought him up from the rock.

14 And he came as far as Siagon; and the foreigners shouted to meet him and ran to meet him; and a spirit of the Lord directed itself upon him, and the cords on his arms became like tow when it smells fire, and the bonds dissolved from his arms.

15 And he found a jawbone of a donkey cast on the road and stretched out his hand and took it and struck a thousand men with it.

16 And Sampson said: With a jawbone of a donkey, wiping out I wiped them out, because with a jawbone of a donkey I struck a thousand men.

17 And it happened when he finished speaking that he cast the jawbone from his hand; and he called that place Removal of the Jawbone.

18 And he was very thirsty; and he cried out to the Lord and said: You gave into the hand of your servant this great deliverance, and now shall I die of thirst and fall into the hand of the uncircumcised?

19 And God opened the wound of the jawbone, and waters came out of it, and he drank, and his spirit returned within him, and he revived. Therefore its name was called Spring Called of the Jawbone until this day. –

20 And he judged Israel in the days of the foreigners twenty years.

Chapter 16

1 And Sampson went from there to Gaza; and he saw a prostitute there and went in to her.

2 And it was reported to the Gazites, saying: Sampson has come here. And they surrounded and lay in wait for him all night at the city gate and kept silent all night, saying: Let us wait until the light in the morning and kill him.

3 And Sampson slept until midnight; and he arose around midnight and took hold of the doors of the city gate and the two posts and lifted them with the bar and put them upon his shoulder and carried them up to the summit of the mountain which faces Chebron and placed them there.

4 And it happened after these things that he loved a woman by the torrent Sorech, and her name was Dalila.

5 And the satraps of the foreigners went up to her and said to her: Deceive him and see in what his great strength lies and by what we can prevail against him and bind him so as to humble him, and we will each give you one thousand one hundred pieces of silver.

6 And Dalila said to Sampson: Tell me in what your great strength lies and with what you may be bound to be humbled.

7 And Sampson said to her: If they bind me with seven moist sinews not dried out, I will grow weak and be like one of the people.

8 And the satraps of the foreigners brought her seven moist sinews not dried out, and she bound him with them;

9 and his ambush sat in the inner room; and she said to him: The foreigners are upon you, Sampson; and he tore the sinews as a strand of the waste fiber is torn when it smells fire; and his strength was not known.

10 And Dalila said to Sampson: Behold, you have deceived me and spoken lies to me; now therefore tell me, please, with what you may be bound.

11 And he said to her: If they bind me firmly with seven new cords with which no work has been done, I will grow weak and be like one of the people.

12 And Dalila took new cords for him and bound him with them and said to him: The foreigners are upon you, Sampson; and the ambush sat in the inner room; and he tore them from his arms like thread.

13 And Dalila said to Sampson: Until now you have deceived me and spoken lies to me; tell me, please, with what you may be bound. And he said to her: If you weave the seven strands of my head with the warp and drive them into the peg in the wall, I will be weak like one of the people.

14 And Dalila made him sleep and wove the seven locks of his head with the stretching and drove them with the pegs into the wall and said to him: The foreigners are upon you, Sampson; and he awoke from his sleep and pulled the pegs with the woven cloth from the wall and the warp, and his strength was not known.

15 And Dalila said to him: How can you say, I have loved you, when your heart is not with me? This is the third time you have deceived me and have not told me in what your great strength lies.

16 And it happened when she wore him down with her words all night and troubled him that he grew fainthearted to the point of death;

17 and he told her everything from his heart and said to her: A razor shall not rise upon my head, for I am a Nazirite of God from my mother's womb, and if I am shaved, my strength will depart from me and I will grow weak and be like all people.

18 And Dalila saw that he had told her everything from his heart and sent and called all the satraps of the foreigners, saying: Come up this once, for he has told me all his heart; and all the satrapies of the foreigners went up to her and brought the silver in their hands.

19 And she made him sleep between her knees; and she called the barber, and he shaved the seven locks of his head; and he began to be humbled, and his strength departed from him.

20 And Dalila said to him: The foreigners are upon you, Sampson. And he awoke from his sleep and said: I will go out and do as always and shake myself free; and he did not know that the Lord had departed from him.

21 And the foreigners seized him and gouged out his eyes; and they brought him down to Gaza and bound him with bronze fetters, and he was grinding in the prison house.

22 And the hair of his head began to grow when it had been shaved.

23 And the satraps of the foreigners gathered to sacrifice a great sacrifice to Dagon their god and to rejoice, and they said: Our god has delivered Sampson our enemy into our hand.

24 And the people saw him and praised their gods and said: Our god has delivered our enemy into our hand, the one who laid waste our land, who multiplied our wounded.

25 And it happened when their heart became glad that they said: Call Sampson from the prison house, and let him play before us. And they called Sampson from the prison house and mocked him and stood him between the two pillars.

26 And Sampson said to the young man leading him by the hand: Let me rest, please, and let me feel the pillars on which the house rests, and I will lean upon them; and the servant did so.

27 And the house was full of men and women, and all the satraps of the foreigners were there, and on the roof about three thousand men and women looking at Sampson being mocked.

28 And Sampson cried out to the Lord and said: Lord, Lord, remember me and strengthen me, please, just this once more, and I will take one vengeance for my two eyes from the foreigners.

29 And Sampson embraced the two middle pillars upon which the house rested, and leaned upon them, one with his right hand and one with his left.

30 And Sampson said: Let my soul die with the foreigners; and he bent with strength, and the house fell upon the satraps and upon all the people in it; and those who died whom Sampson put to death in his death were more than those whom he put to death in his life.

31 And his brothers and all his father's house went down and took him and went up and buried him between Saraa and Esthaol in the tomb of Manoe his father. And he judged Israel twenty years.

Chapter 17

1 And there was a man from Mount Ephraim, and his name was Micha.

2 And he said to his mother: The one thousand one hundred pieces of silver taken from you, about which you adjured and spoke in my ears, behold, the silver is with me; I took it. And his mother said: May my son be blessed by the Lord.

3 And he returned the one thousand one hundred pieces of silver to his mother, and his mother said: With consecration I consecrated the silver to the Lord from my hand alone to make a carved and molten image, and now I will return them to you and give it back to you.

4 And he returned the silver to his mother; and his mother took two hundred pieces of silver and gave it to the founder, and he made it a carved and molten image, and it was in Micha's house.

5 And the man Micha had a house of God; and he made an ephoud and theraphin and filled the hand of one of his sons, and he became his priest. –

6 In those days there was no king in Israel; each man did what was good in his own eyes.

7 And there was a young man from Bethlehem of the division of Judah, of the kin of Judah, and he was a Levite, and he sojourned there.

8 And the man went from the city of Judah, from Bethlehem, to sojourn wherever he might find, and came into Mount Ephraim as far as Micha's house to make his way.

9 And Micha said to him: Where do you come from? And he said to him: I am a Levite from Bethlehem of Judah, and I am going to sojourn wherever I might find.

10 And Micha said to him: Sit with me and become a father and priest for me, and I will give you ten pieces of silver for days and a pair of garments and what is needed for your living. And the Levite went

11 and began to sojourn with the man, and the young man became like one of his sons to him.

12 And Micha filled the Levite's hand, and the young man became his priest and was in Micha's house.

13 And Micha said: Now I know that the Lord has done me good, because the Levite became my priest.

Chapter 18

1 In those days there was no king in Israel. And in those days the tribe of Dan sought an inheritance for itself to dwell in, because an inheritance had not fallen to it until those days among the tribes of Israel.

2 And the sons of Dan sent from their kin five men from their number, sons of strength from Saraa and Esthaol, to inspect the land and trace it out, and said to them: Go and search out the land. And they came to Mount Ephraim as far as Micha's house and rested there.

3 While they were by Micha's house they recognized the voice of the younger Levite servant and turned aside there and said to him: Who brought you here, and what are you doing here, and what do you have here?

4 And he said to them: Thus and thus Micha did for me and hired me, and I became his priest.

5 And they said to him: Ask, please, by God, and we will know whether our way upon which we are going prospers.

6 And the priest said to them: Go in peace; before the Lord is your way in which you are going.

7 And the five men went and came to Laisa; and they saw the people dwelling in it sitting in confidence according to the manner of the Sidonians, quiet in confidence and unable to speak a word, because they were far from Sidon, and they had no dealings with Syria.

8 And the five men came to their brothers in Saraa and Esthaol, and their brothers said to them: Why do you sit?

9 And they said: Arise and let us go up against them; because we entered and walked about in the land as far as Laisa and saw the people dwelling in it in confidence after the manner of the Sidonians, and far away from Sidon, and they had no dealings with Syria; but arise and let us go up against them, for we have found the land and behold, it is very good. And are you silent? Do not hesitate to go to come and inherit the land.

10 When you enter, you will come to a trusting people, and the land is spacious, for God has delivered it into your hand, a place where there is no lack of any thing that is in the land.

11 And six hundred men from the kin of Dan set out from Saraa and Esthaol, girded with implements of war.

12 And they went up and encamped in Kariathiarim in Judah; therefore that place was called Camp of Dan until this day, behold, behind Kariathiarim.

13 They passed from there and came as far as Mount Ephraim and came as far as Micha's house.

14 And the five men who had gone to inspect the land answered and said to their brothers: Do you know that in these houses there are an ephoud and theraphin and a carved and a molten image? And now know what you will do.

15 And they turned aside there and entered the house of the young Levite, Micha's house, and greeted him.

16 And the six hundred men girded with implements of war stood fixed by the entrance of the gateway, those from the sons of Dan.

17 And the five men who had gone to inspect the land went up; coming there they took the carved image and the ephoud and the theraphin and the molten image, while the priest stood fixed by the entrance of the gateway with the six hundred men girded with implements of war.

18 And these entered Micha's house and took the carved image and the ephoud and the theraphin and the molten image. And the priest said to them: What are you doing?

19 And they said to him: Be silent, put your hand upon your mouth and come with us, and you will be a father and priest for us; is it not better for you to be priest of one man's house than to become priest of a tribe and kin in Israel?

20 And the priest's heart became glad, and he took the ephoud and the theraphin and the carved image and the molten image and went into the midst of the people.

21 And they turned and departed; and they set the whole household and his splendid property before them.

22 When they had gone far from Micha's house, behold, Micha and the men with the house with Micha cried out after the sons of Dan.

23 And the sons of Dan turned their faces and said to Micha: What is the matter with you, that you cried out?

24 And Micha said: Because you took my carved image which I made for myself and the priest and departed; and what do I still have? And why do you say to me, Why are you crying out?

25 And the sons of Dan said to him: Let your voice not be heard with us, lest men pained in soul meet you, and you will add your soul and the soul of your house.

26 And the sons of Dan went on their way; and Micha saw that they were stronger than he and turned aside and returned to his house.

27 And they took what Micha made and the priest who was his, and came as far as Laisa against a quiet and trusting people and struck them with the edge of the sword and burned the city;

28 and there was no one to rescue, because it was far from the Sidonians, and they had no dealings with people, and it was in the valley belonging to the house of Roob. And they built the city and dwelt in it

29 and called the name of the city Dan after the name of their father who was born to Israel; and Lais was the city's name formerly.

30 And the sons of Dan set up for themselves Micha's carved image; and Ionathan son of Gersom son of Moses, he and his sons were priests for the tribe of Dan until the day of the deportation of the land.

31 And they placed for themselves Micha's carved image which he made all the days that the house of God was in Selo.

Chapter 19

1 And it happened in those days, and there was no king in Israel. And there was a Levite man sojourning in the flanks of Mount Ephraim, and the man took for himself a woman, a concubine, from Bethlehem of Judah.

2 And his concubine became angry with him and departed from him to her father's house in Bethlehem of Judah and was there for four months of days.

3 And her man arose and went after her to speak to her heart, to reconcile her to himself and lead her back to him, and his young servant with him and a pair of beasts of burden; and he went as far as her father's house, and the young woman's father saw him and was there to meet him.

4 And his father-in-law, the young woman's father, brought him in, and he sat with him three days, and they ate and drank and slept there.

5 And it happened on the fourth day that they arose early in the morning, and he arose to depart; and the young woman's father said to his son-in-law: Support your heart with a piece of bread, and after this go.

6 And both sat and ate together and drank; and the young woman's father said to the man: Begin to lodge, and let your heart be glad.

7 And the man arose to depart; and his father-in-law pressed him, and he lodged there again.

8 And he rose early in the morning on the fifth day to depart; and the young woman's father said: Support your heart with bread and march when the day inclines; and both ate and drank.

9 And the man arose to depart, he and his concubine and his young servant; and his father-in-law, the young woman's father, said to him: Behold, the day has now inclined toward evening; lodge here still today, and let your heart be glad, and you will rise early tomorrow for your way, and depart to your dwelling.

10 And the man did not wish to lodge and arose and departed, and they came opposite Iebous [this is Jerusalem], and with him a pair of saddled beasts of burden, and his concubine with him.

11 While they were still near Iebous and the day had inclined greatly, the young servant said to his master: Come, please, and let us turn aside into this city of the Iebusite and lodge in it.

12 And his master said to him: I will not turn aside into a city of a foreigner which is not of the sons of Israel, and we will pass on as far as Gabaa.

13 And he said to his young servant: Come and let us enter one of the places and lodge in Gabaa or in Rama.

14 And they passed on and departed; for the sun set near Gabaa, which belongs to Benjamin.

15 And they turned aside there to enter and lodge in Gabaa; and they entered and sat in the square of the city, and there was no man to bring them into a house to lodge.

16 And behold, an old man came from his work in the field in the evening; and the man was from Mount Ephraim, and he sojourned in Gabaa, and the men of the place were sons of Benjamin.

17 And looking up with his eyes he saw the traveling man in the square of the city; and the old man said: Where are you going and where do you come from?

18 And he said to him: We are passing from Bethlehem of Judah to the flanks of Mount Ephraim; and I am from there and went as far as Bethlehem of Judah, and I am running back to my house, and there is no man to bring me into a house;

19 and indeed there is straw and fodder for our donkeys, and there is bread and wine for me and your servant woman and the young servant, your servants; there is no lack of anything.

20 And the old man said: Peace to you; only let all your lack be upon me; only do not lodge in the square.

21 And he brought him into his house and placed fodder before his beasts of burden, and they washed their feet and ate and drank.

22 And as their hearts became glad, behold, the men of the city, sons of lawless men, surrounded the house and struck the door and said to the old man, the master of the house: Bring out the man who entered your house so that we may know him.

23 And the man, the master of the house, went out to them and said to them: By no means, brothers, please do not do evil; after this man has entered my house, do not do this foolishness;

24 behold, my virgin daughter and his concubine, I will bring them out, and humble them and do to them what is good in your eyes; but to this man do not do the deed of this foolishness.

25 And the men were unwilling to listen to him. And the man seized his concubine and brought her out to them outside, and they knew her and mocked her all night until morning; and they sent her away as dawn rose.

26 And the woman came toward morning and fell by the door of the gateway of the man's house, where her master was, until it grew light.

27 And her master arose in the morning and opened the doors of the house and went out to depart on his way, and behold, his concubine had fallen by the door, and her hands were on the threshold.

28 And he said to her: Arise and let us go; and she did not answer him, but had died. And he lifted her onto the beast of burden, and the man arose and departed to his place.

29 And he entered his house and took the knife and seized his concubine and divided her according to her bones into twelve portions and sent them to all the tribes of Israel.

30 And it happened that everyone who saw said: Neither has such a thing happened nor has it been seen from the day the sons of Israel came up from Egypt until this day. And he commanded the men to whom he sent them, saying: Thus you shall say to every man of Israel: Has there been anything like this deed from the day the sons of Israel came up from Egypt until this day? Set counsel for yourselves about it, please, and speak.

Chapter 20

1 And all the sons of Israel went out, and the whole congregation assembled as one man from Dan as far as Bersabee and the land of Galaad to the Lord at Massepha.

2 And the position of all the people stood, all the tribes of Israel, in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen drawing the sword.

3 And the sons of Benjamin heard that the sons of Israel had gone up to the Lord at Massepha. And the sons of Israel said: Speak, where did this evil happen?

4 And the Levite man, the man of the woman who had been murdered, answered and said: I and my concubine came to Gabaa of Benjamin to lodge.

5 And the men from Gabaa rose against me and surrounded the house against me by night and wished to kill me, and they humbled my concubine and mocked her, and she died.

6 And I seized my concubine and divided her and sent her throughout every boundary of Israel's inheritance, because they did foolishness in Israel.

7 Behold, all of you, the sons of Israel, give yourselves a word and counsel.

8 And all the people arose as one man, saying: No man of us shall enter his dwelling and no man of us shall turn aside to his house.

9 And now this is the thing we will do to Gabaa: we will go up against it by lot

10 and take ten men for the hundred and a hundred for the thousand and a thousand for the ten thousand to take provisions for the people entering to carry out against Gabaa of Benjamin according to all the foolishness which they did in Israel.

11 And every man of Israel gathered from the cities, coming as one man.

12 And the tribes of Israel sent men throughout the tribe of Benjamin, saying: What is this evil that happened among you?

13 And now give up the impious men in Gabaa, the sons of Belial, and we will put them to death and remove evil from Israel. And the sons of Benjamin were unwilling to listen to the voice of their brothers, the sons of Israel.

14 And the sons of Benjamin gathered from their cities to Gabaa to go out to fight with the sons of Israel.

15 And the sons of Benjamin were counted on that day from the cities, twenty-five thousand men drawing the sword, apart from those dwelling in Gabaa; these were counted as seven hundred chosen young men

16 right-handed on both sides; all these were slingers casting stones at a hair and not missing.

17 And all the men of Israel were counted apart from the sons of Benjamin, four hundred thousand men drawing the sword; all these were men of war.

18 And they arose and went up to Bethel and asked by God, and the sons of Israel said: Who will go up for us, taking the lead to fight with Benjamin? And the Lord said: Judah shall go up taking the lead.

19 And the sons of Israel arose and encamped against Gabaa.

20 And every man of Israel went out to war with Benjamin, and the men of Israel drew up against them for war at Gabaa.

21 And the sons of Benjamin went out from the city and destroyed among Israel on that day twenty-two thousand men upon the ground.

22 And the men of Israel grew strong and again drew up for war in the place where they had drawn up there on the first day.

23 And the sons of Israel went up and wept before the Lord until evening and asked by the Lord, saying: Shall I again draw near to war with Benjamin my brother? And the Lord said: Go up against him.

24 And the sons of Israel approached Benjamin on the second day.

25 And Benjamin went out to meet them from Gabaa on the second day and destroyed eighteen thousand men from the people upon the ground; all these had drawn the sword.

26 And all the sons of Israel and all the people went up and came to Bethel and wept before the Lord and fasted on that day and offered whole burnt offerings of deliverance before the Lord,

27 and the sons of Israel asked by the Lord; and the ark of the covenant of the Lord was there in those days,

28 and Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron stood before it in those days, saying: Shall I again go out to war with the sons of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease? And the Lord said: Go up, for tomorrow I will deliver him into your hand.

29 And the sons of Israel placed an ambush around Gabaa.

30 And Israel drew up against Benjamin on the third day and drew up against Gabaa as once and once.

31 And the sons of Benjamin went out to meet the people and were drawn out of the city and began to strike some of the people as once and once on the roads, one of which goes up to Bethel and one goes up to Gabaa in the field, about thirty men among Israel.

32 And the sons of Benjamin said: They stumble before us as before. And the sons of Israel said: Let us flee and draw them out of the city onto the roads.

33 And every man of Israel arose from his place and drew up at Baalthamar, and the ambush of Israel wrestled from its place west of Gabaa.

34 And ten thousand chosen men from all Israel came opposite Gabaa, and the battle grew heavy; and they did not know that evil had fastened upon them.

35 And the Lord routed Benjamin before Israel, and the sons of Israel destroyed among Benjamin on that day twenty-five thousand one hundred men; all these drew the sword.

36 And Benjamin saw that he had been routed; and the men of Israel gave ground to Benjamin because they trusted in the ambush which they had placed against Gabaa.

37 And the ambush rushed and poured out toward Gabaa, and the ambush went and struck the whole city with the edge of the sword.

38 And the arrangement for the men of Israel with the ambush was that they should raise a torch of the smoke of the city.

39 And the men of Israel turned in the battle, and Benjamin had begun to strike wounded men among the men of Israel, about thirty men, because they said: Surely he is being routed before us as in the former battle.

40 And the torch began to rise from the city, a column of smoke; and Benjamin looked behind him, and behold, the destruction of the city rose to heaven.

41 And the men of Israel turned back, and the men of Benjamin hastened and saw that evil had seized him.

42 And they turned before the men of Israel onto the way of the wilderness, and the battle overtook him, and those from the cities destroyed him in their midst.

43 And they cut down Benjamin, to make him rest with a rest, and trampled him as far as opposite Gabaa from the rising of the sun.

44 And eighteen thousand men from Benjamin fell; with all these were mighty men.

45 And they turned aside and fled to the wilderness toward the rock of Remmon, and they gleaned five thousand men on the roads; and they clung after him as far as Gadaam and struck two thousand men from them.

46 And all those who fell among Benjamin were twenty-five thousand men drawing the sword on that day; with all these were mighty men.

47 And six hundred men turned aside and fled to the wilderness toward the rock of Remmon and sat at the rock of Remmon for four months.

48 And the men of Israel shut off the sons of Benjamin and struck them with the edge of the sword from city in succession as far as cattle, as far as everything found in all the cities; and the cities found they sent up in fire.

Chapter 21

1 And a man of Israel swore at Massepha, saying: No man of us will give his daughter to Benjamin as a wife.

2 And all the people came to Massepha and Bethel and sat there until evening before God and raised their voice and wept a great weeping

3 and said: Why, Lord the God of Israel, has this happened in Israel, that one tribe should be missing from Israel today?

4 And it happened the next day that the people rose early and built an altar there and offered whole burnt offerings of deliverance.

5 And the sons of Israel said: Who did not come up in the assembly from all the tribes of Israel to the Lord? For there was a great oath concerning the one who did not come up to the Lord at Massepha, saying: He shall surely die.

6 And the sons of Israel were moved concerning Benjamin their brother and said: One tribe has been taken away from Israel today;

7 what shall we do for those who remain concerning wives? And we swore by the Lord not to give them any of our daughters as wives.

8 And they said: Which one of the tribes of Israel did not go up to the Lord at Massepha? And behold, no man from Iabis Galaad came to the camp for the assembly.

9 And the people were counted, and behold, there was no man there from those dwelling in Iabis Galaad.

10 And the congregation sent there twelve thousand men from the sons of strength and commanded them, saying: Go and strike all those dwelling in Iabis Galaad with the edge of the sword, the women and the people.

11 And this is the thing you shall do: Every male and every woman who knows the bed of a male you shall devote.

12 And they found from those dwelling in Iabis Galaad four hundred young virgin women who had not known a man in the bed of a male, and they led them to the camp at Selo, which is in the land of Canaan.

13 And all the congregation sent and spoke to Benjamin at the rock of Remmon and called them to peace.

14 And Benjamin returned to the sons of Israel at that time, and they gave them the women who were from the women of Iabis Galaad; and it pleased them thus.

15 And the people were moved for Benjamin, because the Lord had made a breach among the tribes of Israel.

16 And the elders of the congregation said: What shall we do for the remaining ones concerning wives? For women have disappeared from Benjamin.

17 And they said: An inheritance has been saved for Benjamin, and a tribe shall certainly not be wiped out from Israel;

18 and we will not be able to give them wives from our daughters, because we, the sons of Israel, swore, saying: Cursed is the one who gives a wife to Benjamin.

19 And they said: There is a feast to the Lord in Selo from days to days, which is north of Bethel toward the rising of the sun on the road that goes up from Bethel to Sikima and south of Lebanon of Lebona.

20 And they commanded the sons of Benjamin, saying: Go through and lie in ambush in the vineyards;

21 and you will watch, and behold, when the daughters of those dwelling in Selo come out in Selo to dance in dances, you will go out from the vineyards and each man seize a wife for himself from the daughters of Selo and go away to the land of Benjamin.

22 And it will be that when their fathers or their brothers come to plead with you, we will say to them: Show them mercy, because each man did not take his wife in the war; for you did not give them to them; at the time you committed an offense.

23 And the sons of Benjamin did so and took wives according to their number from the dancing women whom they seized; and they departed and returned to their inheritance and built cities for themselves and dwelt in them.

24 And the sons of Israel walked away from there at that time, each man to his tribe and to his kin, and they departed from there, each man to his inheritance. –

25 In those days there was no king in Israel; each man did what was right in his own eyes.

2 Judges

Chapter 1

1 And it happened after the death of Jesus that the sons of Israel asked through the Lord, saying: Who will go up for us against the Canaanites, taking the lead to fight against them?

2 And the Lord said: Judah will go up; behold, I have given the land into his hand.

3 And Judah said to Symeon his brother: Come up with me in my lot, and let us draw up against the Canaanites, and I too will go with you in your lot. And Symeon went with him.

4 And Judah went up, and the Lord delivered the Canaanite and the Pherezite into their hands, and they cut down ten thousand men at Bezek,

5 and they took Adonibezek at Bezek and drew up against him and cut down the Canaanite and the Pherezite.

6 And Adonibezek fled, and they ran after him and took him and cut off the extremities of his hands and the extremities of his feet.

7 And Adonibezek said: Seventy kings, with the extremities of their hands and the extremities of their feet cut off, were gathering what was under my table; as I did, so God has repaid me. And they bring him to Jerusalem, and he died there.

8 And the sons of Judah fought Jerusalem and took it and struck it with the edge of the sword and burned the city with fire.

9 And after these things the sons of Judah went down to fight against the Canaanite dwelling in the hill country and the south and the plain.

10 And Judah went against the Canaanite dwelling in Chebron, and Chebron came out opposite; and the name of Chebron formerly was Kariatharboxepher. And they struck Sessi and Achinaan and Tholmin, offspring of Enak.

11 And they went up from there against those dwelling in Dabir; but the name of Dabir formerly was Kariathsophar, City of Letters.

12 And Chaleb said: Whoever strikes the City of Letters and takes it first, I will give him Ascha my daughter for a wife.

13 And Gothoniel son of Kenez brother of Chaleb, the younger, took it first, and Chaleb gave him Ascha his daughter for a wife.

14 And it happened as she entered that Gothoniel urged her to ask her father for a field, and she murmured and cried out from the beast of burden: You have given me away into a land of the south. And Chaleb said to her: What is it for you?

15 And Ascha said to him: Give me, please, a blessing, because you have given me away into a land of the south, and you will give me a redemption of water. And Chaleb gave her according to her heart a redemption of the heights and a redemption of the lowlands.

16 And the sons of Iothor the Kenite, the father-in-law of Moses, went up from the city of palms with the sons of Judah into the wilderness in the south of Judah, which is by the descent of Arad, and dwelt with the people. –

17 And Judah went with Symeon his brother and cut down the Canaanite dwelling in Sephek; and they destroyed them and called the name of the city Devoted Thing.

18 And Judah did not inherit Gaza nor its boundaries nor Ascalon nor its boundaries nor Akkaron nor its boundaries nor Azotus nor its surrounding lands.

19 And the Lord was with Judah, and he inherited the mountain; because they were unable to destroy those dwelling in the valley, because Rechab had divided it for them.

20 And they gave Chebron to Chaleb, as Moses spoke, and he inherited from there the three cities of the sons of Enak.

21 And the sons of Benjamin did not inherit the Iebusite dwelling in Jerusalem, and the Iebusite dwelt with the sons of Benjamin in Jerusalem until this day.

22 And the sons of Joseph, they too, went up to Bethel, and the Lord was with them.

23 And they encamped against and inspected Bethel; but the name of their city formerly was Louza.

24 And those keeping watch saw, and behold, a man was going out of the city; and they took him and said to him: Show us the entrance of the city, and we will deal mercifully with you.

25 And he showed them the entrance of the city, and they struck the city with the edge of the sword, but the man and his kin they sent away.

26 And the man went to the land of the Chettites and built a city there and called its name Louza; that is its name until this day.

27 And Manasse did not remove Baithsan, which is the city of the Scythians, nor its daughter towns nor its surrounding inhabitants, nor Thanak nor its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Dor nor its daughter towns, nor the one dwelling in Balak nor its surrounding inhabitants nor its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Magedo nor its surrounding inhabitants nor its daughter towns, nor those dwelling in Ieblaam nor its surrounding inhabitants nor its daughter towns; and the Canaanite began to dwell in this land.

28 And it happened when Israel grew strong that he made the Canaanite tribute, and in removing him he did not remove him.

29 And Ephraim did not remove the Canaanite dwelling in Gazer; and the Canaanite dwelt in his midst in Gazer and became tribute.

30 And Zabulon did not remove those dwelling in Kedron nor those dwelling in Domana; and the Canaanite dwelt in their midst and became tribute for him.

31 And Aser did not remove those dwelling in Akcho, and it became tribute for him, nor those dwelling in Dor and those dwelling in Sidon and those dwelling in Aalaph and Aschazi and Chelba and Nai and Ereo.

32 And Aser dwelt in the midst of the Canaanite dwelling in the land, because he was unable to remove him.

33 And Nephthali did not remove those dwelling in Baithsamys and those dwelling in Baithanath, and Nephthali dwelt in the midst of the Canaanite dwelling in the land; but those dwelling in Baithsamys and Baitheneth became tribute for them.

34 And the Amorite pressed the sons of Dan into the mountain, because they did not allow him to go down into the valley.

35 And the Amorite began to dwell in the sherd-like mountain, where the bears were and where the foxes were, in Myrsinon and in Thalabin; and the hand of the house of Joseph was heavy upon the Amorite, and he became tribute for them.

36 And the boundary of the Amorite was from the ascent of Akrabin, from the Rock and upward.

Chapter 2

1 And an angel of the Lord went up from Galgal to Klauchmon and to Bethel and to the house of Israel and said to them: Thus says the Lord: I brought you up from Egypt and brought you into the land which I swore to your fathers, and I said: I will not scatter my covenant with you forever;

2 and you shall not make a covenant with those settled in this land nor bow down to their gods, but you shall shatter their carved images and pull down their altars. And you did not listen to my voice, because you did these things.

3 And I said: I will certainly not remove them from before you, and they will be constraints for you, and their gods will be a stumbling block for you.

4 And it happened when the angel of the Lord spoke these words to all the sons of Israel that the people raised their voice and wept.

5 And they named that place Weepings; and they sacrificed there to the Lord.

6 And Jesus sent the people away, and each man came to his inheritance to inherit the land.

7 And the people served the Lord all the days of Jesus and all the days of the elders who lived long after Jesus, who knew all the great work of the Lord which he did in Israel.

8 And Jesus son of Naue, servant of the Lord, died at one hundred and ten years of age.

9 And they buried him within the boundary of his inheritance in Thamnathares in Mount Ephraim to the north of Mount Gaas.

10 And indeed all that generation were added to their fathers, and another generation arose after them who did not know the Lord nor indeed the work which he did in Israel.

11 And the sons of Israel did evil before the Lord and served the Baalim.

12 And they abandoned the Lord the God of their fathers who brought them out of the land of Egypt and went after other gods from the gods of the nations around them and bowed down to them and provoked the Lord to anger,

13 and they abandoned him and served Baal and the Astartes.

14 And the Lord was angry in wrath with Israel and delivered them into the hands of plunderers, and they plundered them thoroughly; and he sold them into the hands of their enemies round about, and they were no longer able to stand before their enemies.

15 In all the things in which they went out, the hand of the Lord was upon them for evils, as the Lord spoke and as the Lord swore to them, and he pressed them very hard.

16 And the Lord raised up judges, and the Lord saved them from the hand of those plundering them.

17 And even the judges they did not obey, because they went whoring after other gods and bowed down to them; and they turned aside quickly from the way in which their fathers walked to listen to the words of the Lord; they did not do thus.

18 And because the Lord raised up judges for them, the Lord was with the judge and saved them from the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge, because the Lord was moved by their groaning before those besieging them and pressing them.

19 And it happened when the judge died that they turned back and again acted more corruptly than their fathers, going after other gods to serve them and bow down to them; they did not cast aside their practices and their hard ways.

20 And the Lord was angry in wrath with Israel and said: Because this nation abandoned my covenant which I commanded their fathers and did not listen to my voice,

21 I too will no longer continue to remove a man from before them from the nations which Jesus son of Naue left in the land and allowed to remain,

22 to test Israel by them, whether they keep the way of the Lord to walk in it as their fathers kept it, or not.

23 And the Lord allowed these nations to remain, not removing them quickly, and did not deliver them into the hand of Jesus.

Chapter 3

1 And these are the nations which the Lord allowed to remain so as to test Israel by them, all those who had not known the wars of Canaan,

2 except on account of the generations of the sons of Israel to teach them war, except that those before them had not known them;

3 the five satrapies of the foreigners and all the Canaanite and the Sidonian and the Euaite dwelling in Lebanon from Mount Aermon as far as Labohamath.

4 And it happened so as to test Israel by them, to know whether they would listen to the commandments of the Lord which he commanded their fathers by the hand of Moses.

5 And the sons of Israel dwelt among the Canaanite and the Chettite and the Amorite and the Pherezite and the Euaite and the Iebusite,

6 and took their daughters for themselves as wives and gave their daughters to their sons and served their gods.

7 And the sons of Israel did evil before the Lord and forgot the Lord their God and served the Baalim and the groves.

8 And the Lord was angry in wrath with Israel and sold them into the hand of Chousarsathaim king of Syria of the Rivers. And the sons of Israel served Chousarsathaim eight years.

9 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord; and the Lord raised up a savior for Israel and saved them, Gothoniel son of Kenez brother of Chaleb, younger than he,

10 and a spirit of the Lord came upon him, and he judged Israel and went out to war against Chousarsathaim; and the Lord delivered Chousarsathaim king of Syria of the Rivers into his hand, and his hand became strong against Chousarsathaim.

11 And the land was quiet forty years; and Gothoniel son of Kenez died.

12 And the sons of Israel again did evil before the Lord. And the Lord strengthened Eglom king of Moab against Israel because they had done evil before the Lord.

13 And he gathered to himself all the sons of Ammon and Amalek and went and struck Israel and inherited the city of palms.

14 And the sons of Israel served Eglom king of Moab eighteen years.

15 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord; and he raised up for them a savior, Aod son of Gera son of the Iemeni, a man right-handed on both sides. And the sons of Israel sent gifts by his hand to Eglom king of Moab.

16 And Aod made for himself a double-edged knife, a span in its length, and girded it under the cloak on his right thigh.

17 And he went and brought the gifts to Eglom king of Moab; and Eglom was a very handsome man.

18 And it happened when Aod finished bringing the gifts, he sent away those carrying the gifts;

19 and he himself returned from the carved images by Galgal. And Aod said, I have a secret word for you, O king. And Eglom said to him, Be silent; and he sent away from himself all those attending him.

20 And Aod entered to him, and he was sitting in his summer upper room, by himself alone. And Aod said, I have a word of God for you, O king; and Eglom rose from the throne near him.

21 And it happened as he rose that Aod stretched out his left hand and took the knife from above his right thigh and thrust it into his belly.

22 And he drove in even the handle after the blade, and the fat closed over the blade, for he did not draw the knife out of his belly. And Aod went out to the porch

23 and went out past those stationed there and shut the doors of the upper room upon him and wedged them shut;

24 and he went out. And his servants entered and saw, and behold, the doors of the upper room were wedged shut, and they said, Perhaps he is emptying his feet in the summer chamber?

25 And they waited until they were ashamed, and behold, there was no one opening the doors of the upper room; and they took the key and opened, and behold, their lord had fallen upon the ground, dead.

26 And Aod escaped while they were in confusion, and there was no one taking notice of him; and he passed the carved images and escaped to Setirotha.

27 And it happened when Aod came to the land of Israel that he sounded a horn in the hill country of Ephraim; and the sons of Israel came down with him from the mountain, and he was before them.

28 And he said to them, Come down after me, for the Lord God has delivered our enemies, Moab, into our hand. And they came down after him and seized beforehand the crossings of the Jordan belonging to Moab, and he did not permit a man to cross.

29 And they struck Moab on that day, about ten thousand men, every stout man and every man of strength, and no man escaped.

30 And Moab was put to shame on that day under the hand of Israel, and the land rested eighty years, and Aod judged them until he died.

31 And after him Samegar son of Dinach arose and struck the foreigners, six hundred men, with the oxgoad; and he too saved Israel.

Chapter 4

1 And the sons of Israel continued to do evil before the Lord; and Aod died.

2 And the Lord gave them over into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, who reigned in Asor; and the commander of his force was Sisara, and he dwelt in Arisoth of the nations.

3 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord, for he had nine hundred iron chariots, and he oppressed Israel with force for twenty years.

4 And Debbora, a woman, a prophetess, wife of Laphidoth, judged Israel at that time.

5 And she sat under the palm tree of Debbora between Rama and Bethel in the hill country of Ephraim, and the sons of Israel went up to her for judgment.

6 And Debbora sent and called Barak son of Abineem from Kades of Nephthali and said to him, Did not the Lord God of Israel command you, And you shall go to Mount Thabor and take with yourself ten thousand men from the sons of Nephthali and from the sons of Zabulon?

7 And I will bring to you, to the torrent Kison, Sisara the commander of Jabin's force and his chariots and his multitude, and I will deliver him into your hands.

8 And Barak said to her, If you go with me, I will go, and if you do not go, I will not go; for I do not know the day on which the Lord prospers the angel with me.

9 And she said, Going, I will go with you; nevertheless know that your preeminence will not be upon the way in which you go, for into a woman's hand the Lord will deliver Sisara. And Debbora rose and went with Barak from Kades.

10 And Barak summoned Zabulon and Nephthali from Kades, and ten thousand men went up at his feet; and Debbora went up with him.

11 And Chaber the Kenite had separated from Kain, from the sons of Iobab, Moses' father-in-law, and pitched his tent as far as the oak of those seeking advantage, which is near Kedes.

12 And it was reported to Sisara that Barak son of Abineem had gone up to Mount Thabor.

13 And Sisara summoned all his chariots, nine hundred iron chariots, and all the people with him, from Arisoth of the nations to the torrent Kison.

14 And Debbora said to Barak, Rise, for this is the day on which the Lord has delivered Sisara into your hand, for the Lord will go out before you. And Barak went down from Mount Thabor, and ten thousand men after him.

15 And the Lord threw Sisara and all his chariots and all his camp into confusion by the edge of the sword before Barak; and Sisara came down from upon his chariot and fled on his feet.

16 And Barak pursued after the chariots and after the camp as far as Arisoth of the nations; and all the camp of Sisara fell by the edge of the sword, not one was left.

17 And Sisara fled on his feet to the tent of Jael, wife of Chaber, companion of the Kenite, for there was peace between Jabin king of Asor and the house of Chaber the Kenite.

18 And Jael went out to meet Sisara and said to him, Turn aside, my lord, turn aside to me; do not fear. And he turned aside to her into the tent, and she covered him with a covering.

19 And Sisara said to her, Give me, please, a little water to drink, for I am thirsty. And she opened the skin of milk and gave him drink and covered him.

20 And Sisara said to her, Stand, please, at the door of the tent, and it shall be, if a man comes to you and asks you and says, Is there a man here? then you shall say, There is not.

21 And Jael wife of Chaber took the tent peg and put the hammer in her hand and entered to him secretly and drove the peg into his temple, and it passed through into the ground; and he, being beside himself, grew dark and died.

22 And behold, Barak was pursuing Sisara, and Jael went out to meet him and said to him, Come and I will show you the man whom you seek. And he entered to her, and behold, Sisara was cast down dead, and the peg was in his temple.

23 And God routed Jabin king of Canaan on that day before the sons of Israel.

24 And the hand of the sons of Israel went on, going and growing hard against Jabin king of Canaan, until they utterly destroyed Jabin king of Canaan.

Chapter 5

1 And Debbora and Barak son of Abineem sang on that day, saying,

2 A covering was uncovered in Israel; when the people volunteered, bless the Lord.

3 Hear, kings, and give ear, satraps; I am for the Lord, I am, I will sing, I will make music to the Lord, the God of Israel.

4 Lord, when you went out in Seir, when you departed from the field of Edom, the earth shook, and the heaven dripped dews, and the clouds dripped water;

5 mountains were shaken before the Lord Eloi, this Sinai before the Lord God of Israel.

6 In the days of Samegar son of Anath, in the days of Jael, roads ceased, and they traveled paths, they traveled crooked roads;

7 strong ones ceased in Israel, they ceased, until Debbora arose, until a mother arose in Israel.

8 They chose new gods; then cities of rulers fought; if a shield and spear should be seen among forty thousand in Israel.

9 My heart is toward those appointed in Israel; those volunteering among the people, bless the Lord.

10 You who ride upon a female donkey of midday, who sit upon a judgment seat, and who travel upon roads of councilors on the way,

11 tell of it from the voice of those striking up among those drawing water; there they will give righteous acts to the Lord, righteous acts, increase in Israel. Then the Lord's people went down to the cities.

12 Awake, awake, Debbora, awake, awake, speak a song; rise, Barak, and take captive your captivity, son of Abineem.

13 Then a remnant went down to the strong; the Lord's people went down to him among the mighty.

14 From me Ephraim rooted them out in Amalek; after you, Benjamin, among your peoples. With me from Machir came down searchers, and from Zabulon those drawing with a scribe's rod of narration.

15 And leaders in Issachar were with Debbora and Barak; so Barak sent into the valleys at his feet. In the divisions of Reuben there were great reachings of heart.

16 Why did they sit among the twofold allotment to hear the whistling of messengers? In the divisions of Reuben there were great examinations of heart.

17 Galaad encamped beyond the Jordan; and Dan, why does he sojourn by ships? Aser sat on the seacoast and will encamp at his outlets.

18 Zabulon is a people who reproached his soul unto death, and Nephthali upon the heights of the field.

19 Their kings came, they drew up for battle; then kings of Canaan fought in Thanaach by the water of Megeddo; they took no gift of silver.

20 From heaven the stars drew up for battle; from their paths they drew up against Sisara.

21 The torrent Kison swept them away, the torrent of ancient ones, the torrent Kison; my mighty soul will trample him.

22 Then the heels of a horse were impeded; with haste his mighty ones hastened.

23 Curse Meroz, said an angel of the Lord; curse, utterly accursed is everyone dwelling in it, for they did not come to the Lord's aid, to aid among the mighty.

24 May Jael wife of Chaber the Kenite be blessed among women; above women in tents may she be blessed.

25 He asked for water; she gave milk; in a basin of those who excel she brought butter.

26 Her left hand she stretched toward the peg and her right toward the hammer of those who toil; and she hammered Sisara, nailed through his head and struck, nailed through his temple.

27 Between her feet he rolled down, fell and slept; between her feet, reclining, he fell; as he reclined, there he fell, spent.

28 Through the window the mother of Sisara peered out beyond the lattice: Why was his chariot ashamed? Why have the feet of his chariots delayed?

29 Her wise ruling women answered her, and she herself returned her words to herself:

30 Will they not find him dividing spoils? A merciful one will show mercy for the head of a man; spoils of dyed fabrics for Sisara, spoils of dyed fabrics of embroidery, embroidered dyed fabrics themselves, spoils for his neck.

31 Thus may all your enemies perish, Lord; and those who love him are like the going forth of the sun in its strength. And the land rested forty years.

Chapter 6

1 And the sons of Israel did evil before the Lord, and the Lord gave them into the hand of Madiam for seven years.

2 And the hand of Madiam grew strong over Israel; and the sons of Israel made for themselves, because of Madiam, the holes in the mountains and the caves and the hanging places.

3 And it happened whenever the sons of Israel sowed, Madiam and Amalek came up, and the sons of the east came up with them;

4 and they encamped against them and destroyed their crops as far as Gaza, and left no means of life in the land of Israel, nor among the flocks an ox and a donkey;

5 for they and their possessions came up, and their tents arrived like a multitude of locusts, and there was no number for them and their camels, and they came into the land of Israel and destroyed it.

6 And Israel was very impoverished because of Madiam, and the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord

7 because of Madiam.

8 And the Lord sent a man, a prophet, to the sons of Israel, and he said to them, Thus says the Lord God of Israel: I am he who brought you up from the land of Egypt and led you out from your house of slavery

9 and delivered you from the hand of Egypt and from the hand of all who oppressed you, and cast them out before you and gave you their land,

10 and said to you, I am the Lord your God; you shall not fear the gods of the Amorite, among whom you will dwell in their land. And you did not listen to my voice.

11 And an angel of the Lord came and sat under the terebinth in Ephratha belonging to Ioas father of Esdri, and Gedeon his son was beating wheat in a winepress to escape from Madiam.

12 And the angel of the Lord appeared to him and said to him, The Lord is with you, mighty one of forces.

13 And Gedeon said to him, In me, my lord, and if the Lord is with us, why have these evils found us? And where are all his wonders which our fathers recounted to us, saying, Did not the Lord bring us up out of Egypt? And now he has cast us off and given us into the hand of Madiam.

14 And the angel of the Lord turned to him and said, Go in this strength of yours and save Israel from the hand of Madiam; behold, I have sent you.

15 And Gedeon said to him, In me, my lord, by what shall I save Israel? Behold, my thousand has become weak in Manasse, and I am the least in my father's house.

16 And the angel of the Lord said to him, The Lord will be with you, and you shall strike Madiam as one man.

17 And Gedeon said to him, But if I have found mercy in your eyes, then you will do for me today all that you have spoken with me;

18 do not depart from here until I come to you, and I will bring out the sacrifice and set it before you. And he said, I will sit until you return.

19 And Gedeon went in and prepared a kid of the goats and unleavened bread from an ephah of flour, and put the meat in a basket and poured the broth into a pot and brought them out to him under the terebinth and came near.

20 And the angel of God said to him, Take the meat and the unleavened bread and place them by that rock and pour out the broth beside it; and he did so.

21 And the angel of the Lord extended the tip of the staff in his hand and touched the meat and the unleavened bread, and fire rose up from the rock and consumed the meat and the unleavened bread; and the angel of the Lord went from his sight.

22 And Gedeon saw that this was an angel of the Lord, and Gedeon said, Ah, ah, my lord Lord, for I have seen an angel of the Lord face to face.

23 And the Lord said to him, Peace to you; do not fear; you shall certainly not die.

24 And Gedeon built an altar there to the Lord and called it Peace of the Lord; to this day it is still in Ephratha of the father of Esdri.

25 And it happened on that night that the Lord said to him, Take the calf, the bull that belongs to your father, and a second calf, seven years old, and you shall tear down the altar of Baal that belongs to your father, and destroy the grove upon it;

26 and you shall build an altar to the Lord your God upon the summit of this Maouek in the array, and take the second calf and offer a whole burnt offering with the wood of the grove which you shall destroy.

27 And Gedeon took ten men from his servants and did as the Lord had spoken to him; and it happened that, because he feared his father's house and the men of the city to do it by day, he did it by night.

28 And the men of the city rose early in the morning, and behold, the altar of Baal had been torn down and the grove upon it destroyed; and they saw the second calf which he had offered upon the altar that had been built.

29 And each man said to his neighbor, Who did this thing? And they sought and investigated and learned that Gedeon son of Ioas had done this thing.

30 And the men of the city said to Ioas, Bring out your son, and let him die, because he tore down Baal's altar and destroyed the grove upon it.

31 And Ioas said to all the men who rose against him, Are you now pleading on behalf of Baal? Or will you save him? Whoever pleads for him, let him be put to death by morning; if he is a god, let him plead for himself, because he tore down his altar.

32 And he called him Iarbaal on that day, saying, Let Baal plead against him, because his altar was torn down.

33 And all Madiam and Amalek and the sons of the east assembled together and encamped in the valley of Ezreel.

34 And the spirit of the Lord strengthened Gedeon, and he sounded a horn, and Abiezer was afraid behind him.

35 And he sent messengers into all Manasse and into Aser and into Zabulon and Nephthali, and he went up to meet them.

36 And Gedeon said to God, If you save Israel by my hand, as you have spoken,

37 behold, I am placing the fleece of wool on the threshing floor; if dew comes upon the fleece alone and dryness upon all the ground, I shall know that you will save Israel by my hand, as you have spoken.

38 And it happened thus; and he rose early on the next day and squeezed the fleece, and dew dripped from the fleece, a full basin of water.

39 And Gedeon said to God, Let your anger, please, not be kindled against me, and I shall speak once more; and I shall make trial once more with the fleece: let dryness come upon the fleece alone, and upon all the ground let there be dew.

40 And God did thus on that night, and there was dryness upon the fleece alone, and upon all the ground there was dew.

Chapter 7

1 And Iarbal [that is Gedeon] and all the people with him rose early and encamped by the spring of Arad, and the camp of Madiam was to his north from Gabaath Amora in the valley.

2 And the Lord said to Gedeon, The people with you are too many for me to deliver Madiam into their hand, lest Israel boast against me, saying, My hand saved me;

3 and now speak, please, in the ears of the people, saying, Who is fearful and timid? Let him return and withdraw from Mount Galaad. And twenty-two thousand returned from the people, and ten thousand remained.

4 And the Lord said to Gedeon, The people are still many; bring them down to the water, and I shall sift them for you there; and it shall be that whoever I say to you, This one shall go with you, he shall go with you; and anyone of whom I say to you, This one shall not go with you, he shall not go with you.

5 And he brought the people down to the water; and the Lord said to Gedeon, Everyone who laps with his tongue from the water as a dog laps, you shall set him apart, and everyone who bends upon his knees to drink.

6 And the number of those who lapped with their hand to their mouth was three hundred men, and all the rest of the people bent upon their knees to drink water.

7 And the Lord said to Gedeon, With the three hundred men who lapped I will save you and give Madiam into your hand, and all the people shall go, each man to his place.

8 And they took the people's provisions in their hand and their horns, and he sent every man of Israel away, each to his tent, and kept the three hundred men. And the camp of Madiam was below him in the valley.

9 And it happened on that night that the Lord said to him, Rise and go down into the camp, for I have delivered it into your hand;

10 and if you fear to go down, go down, you and Phara your servant, into the camp

11 and hear what they will say; and after this your hands will grow strong, and you will go down into the camp. And he and Phara his servant went down toward the beginning of the fifty who were in the camp.

12 And Madiam and Amalek and all the sons of the east were spread out in the valley like locusts in multitude, and their camels had no number, but were like sand upon the seashore in multitude.

13 And Gedeon came, and behold, a man was telling a dream to his neighbor and said, Behold, I dreamed a dream, and behold, a cake of barley bread rolled in the camp of Madiam and came as far as the tent and struck it, and it fell, and turned it upward, and the tent fell.

14 And his neighbor answered and said, This is nothing other than the sword of Gedeon son of Ioas, a man of Israel; God has delivered Madiam and all the camp into his hand.

15 And it happened when Gedeon heard the account of the dream and its interpretation that he bowed down to the Lord and returned to the camp of Israel and said, Rise, for the Lord has delivered the camp of Madiam into our hand.

16 And he divided the three hundred men into three companies and gave horns into everyone's hand and empty jars and torches in the jars

17 and said to them, Watch me, and thus you shall do; and behold, I am entering at the edge of the camp, and it shall be that as I do, so shall you do;

18 and I shall sound the horn, I and all with me; sound your horns around the whole camp and say, For the Lord and for Gedeon.

19 And Gedeon and the hundred men with him entered at the edge of the camp at the beginning of the middle watch, and, rousing, they roused the guards and sounded the horns and shook out the jars in their hands.

20 And the three companies sounded the horns and broke the jars and held the torches in their left hands and the horns for sounding in their right hands and cried out, A sword for the Lord and for Gedeon.

21 And each man stood in his place around the camp, and all the camp ran and signaled and fled.

22 And they sounded the three hundred horns, and the Lord set each man's sword against his neighbor throughout the camp, and the camp fled as far as Bethseedta Garagatha, as far as the edge of Abomeoula by Tabath.

23 And the men of Israel from Nephthali and from Aser and from all Manasse were summoned and pursued Madiam.

24 And Gedeon sent messengers throughout all the hill country of Ephraim, saying, Come down to meet Madiam and seize the water for yourselves as far as Baithera and the Jordan; and every man of Ephraim was summoned, and they seized the water beforehand as far as Baithera and the Jordan.

25 And they captured the rulers of Madiam, Oreb and Zeb, and killed Oreb at Sour and killed Zeb at Iakephzeph and pursued Madiam; and they brought the heads of Oreb and Zeb to Gedeon from beyond the Jordan.

Chapter 8

1 And the men of Ephraim said to Gedeon, What is this thing you have done to us, not calling us when you went to fight against Madiam? And they disputed with him strongly.

2 And he said to them, What have I done now compared with you? Is not Ephraim's gleaning better than Abiezer's harvest?

3 Into your hand the Lord delivered the rulers of Madiam, Oreb and Zeb; and what was I able to do like you? Then their spirit relaxed toward him when he spoke this word.

4 And Gedeon came to the Jordan, and he and the three hundred men with him crossed, hungry and pursuing.

5 And he said to the men of Sokchoth, Give, please, loaves for food to this people at my feet, for they are failing, and behold, I am pursuing Zebee and Selmana, kings of Madiam.

6 And the rulers of Sokchoth said, Are the hands of Zebee and Selmana now in your hand? We shall not give loaves to your force.

7 And Gedeon said, Therefore when the Lord gives Zebee and Selmana into my hand, I shall thresh your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with the abarkenin.

8 And he went up from there to Phanouel and spoke to them likewise, and the men of Phanouel answered him as the men of Sokchoth had answered.

9 And Gedeon said to the men of Phanouel, When I return in peace I shall tear down this tower. –

10 And Zebee and Selmana were in Karkar, and their camp with them, about fifteen thousand, all those left from the whole camp of the foreigners; and those who had fallen were a hundred and twenty thousand men drawing a sword.

11 And Gedeon went up by the road of those dwelling in tents east of Nabai and Iegebal; and he struck the camp, while the camp was confident.

12 And Zebee and Selmana fled, and he pursued them and seized the two kings of Madiam, Zebee and Selmana, and threw the whole camp into confusion. –

13 And Gedeon son of Ioas returned from the battle from above the battle line of Ares.

14 And he captured a young man of the men of Sokchoth and questioned him, and he wrote for him the names of the rulers of Sokchoth and their elders, seventy-seven men.

15 And Gedeon came to the rulers of Sokchoth and said, Behold Zebee and Selmana, concerning whom you reproached me, saying, Are the hands of Zebee and Selmana now in your hand, that we should give loaves to the men who are failing?

16 And he took the elders of the city with the thorns of the wilderness and the barakenim and threshed the men of the city with them.

17 And he tore down the tower of Phanouel and killed the men of the city. –

18 And he said to Zebee and Selmana, Where are the men whom you killed in Thabor? And they said, Like you, so were they, in the likeness of a king's son.

19 And Gedeon said, They were my brothers and sons of my mother; as the Lord lives, if you had kept them alive, I would not have killed you.

20 And he said to Iether his firstborn, Rise and kill them; and the young man did not draw his sword, for he was afraid, for he was still younger.

21 And Zebee and Selmana said, Rise yourself and fall upon us, for your strength is as a man's. And Gedeon rose and killed Zebee and Selmana and took the crescents on the necks of their camels.

22 And the men of Israel said to Gedeon, Lord, rule us, both you and your son, for you saved us from the hand of Madiam.

23 And Gedeon said to them, I shall not rule, and my son shall not rule among you; the Lord shall rule you.

24 And Gedeon said to them, I shall ask a request of you: each man give me an earring from his spoils; for they had gold earrings, for they were Ishmaelites.

25 And they said, Giving, we shall give; and he spread out his cloak, and each man cast there an earring from his spoils.

26 And the weight of the gold earrings which he asked for was a thousand and five hundred gold pieces, apart from the crescents and the necklaces and the garments and purple garments upon the kings of Madiam, and besides the ornaments on the necks of their camels.

27 And Gedeon made it into an ephod and set it up in his city, Ephratha; and all Israel went whoring after it there, and it became a stumbling block to Gedeon and his house.

28 And Madiam was brought low before the sons of Israel and did not again lift up its head. And the land rested forty years in the days of Gedeon. –

29 And Ierobaal son of Ioas went and dwelt in his house.

30 And Gedeon had seventy sons who came forth from his thighs, for he had many wives.

31 And his concubine was in Sychem; and she too bore him a son, and he gave him the name Abimelech.

32 And Gedeon son of Ioas died in his city and was buried in the tomb of Ioas his father in Ephratha of Abiesdri.

33 And it happened when Gedeon died that the sons of Israel turned back and went whoring after the Baals, and they made Baal of the covenant their god.

34 And the sons of Israel did not remember the Lord God who had delivered them from the hand of all those oppressing them all around.

35 And they did not show mercy to the house of Ierobaal [that is Gedeon] according to all the good that he had done with Israel.

Chapter 9

1 And Abimelech son of Ierobaal went to Sychem to his mother's brothers and spoke to them and to all the kin of his mother's father's house, saying,

2 Speak, please, in the ears of all the men of Sychem: What is better for you, that seventy men, all sons of Ierobaal, rule you, or that one man rule you? And remember that I am your bone and your flesh.

3 And his mother's brothers spoke concerning him in the ears of all the men of Sychem all these words, and their heart inclined after Abimelech, for they said, He is our brother.

4 And they gave him seventy pieces of silver from the house of Baalberith, and Abimelech hired for himself empty and timid men, and they went after him.

5 And he entered his father's house in Ephratha and killed his brothers, the sons of Ierobaal, seventy men, upon one stone; and Ioathan son of Ierobaal, the youngest, was left, for he hid.

6 And all the men of Sikimoi and all the house of Bethmaalon gathered and went and made Abimelech king beside the oak that was found by the standing place in Sikimoi.

7 And it was reported to Ioathan, and he went and stood upon the summit of Mount Garizin and raised his voice and wept and said to them, Hear me, men of Sikimoi, and God will hear you.

8 Going, the trees went to anoint a king over themselves and said to the olive tree, Reign over us.

9 And the olive tree said to them, Shall I leave my richness, by which men glorify God, and go to sway over the trees?

10 And the trees said to the fig tree, Come, reign over us.

11 And the fig tree said to them, Shall I leave my sweetness and my good produce and go to sway over the trees?

12 And the trees said to the vine, Come, you reign over us.

13 And the vine said to them, Shall I leave my wine, which gladdens God and men, and go to sway over the trees?

14 And all the trees said to the bramble, Come, you reign over us.

15 And the bramble said to the trees, If in truth you anoint me to reign over you, come and stand in my shade; but if not, may fire go out from me and consume the cedars of Lebanon. –

16 And now, if in truth and integrity you acted and made Abimelech king, and if you showed goodness to Ierobaal and to his house, and if you acted toward him according to the repayment of his hand,

17 – as my father fought for you and cast away his life in opposition and delivered you from the hand of Madiam,

18 and you rose against my father's house today and killed his sons, seventy men upon one stone, and made Abimelech, the son of his maidservant, king over the men of Sikimoi because he is your brother –

19 and if in truth and integrity you acted toward Ierobaal and his house on this day, may you rejoice in Abimelech, and may he too rejoice over you.

20 But if not, may fire come out from Abimelech and consume the men of Sikimoi and the house of Bethmaallon, and may fire come out from the men of Sikimoi and from the house of Bethmaallon and consume Abimelech. –

21 And Ioathan fled and escaped and went as far as Baier and lived there because of Abimelech his brother.

22 And Abimelech ruled over Israel for three years.

23 And God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Sikimoi, and the men of Sikimoi dealt treacherously with the house of Abimelech,

24 to bring the injustice against the seventy sons of Ierobaal and lay their blood upon Abimelech their brother who killed them, and upon the men of Sikimoi because they strengthened his hands to kill his brothers.

25 And the men of Sikimoi set men in ambush for him on the mountain tops, and they plundered everyone passing by them on the road; and it was reported to King Abimelech.

26 And Gaal son of Iobel and his brothers came and passed into Sikimoi, and the men of Sikimoi put their hope in him.

27 And they went out into the field and harvested their vineyards and trod and made elloulim and brought them into the house of their god and ate and drank and cursed Abimelech.

28 And Gaal son of Iobel said, Who is Abimelech and who is the son of Sychem that we should serve him? Is he not a son of Ierobaal, and Zeboul his overseer his servant, with the men of Emmor father of Sychem? And why should we serve him?

29 And who would put this people in my hand? I would remove Abimelech and say to him, Increase your force and come out.

30 And Zeboul, ruler of the city, heard the words of Gaal son of Iobel and became angry with wrath.

31 And he sent messengers to Abimelech secretly, saying, Behold, Gaal son of Iobel and his brothers are coming to Sychem, and behold, they are besieging the city against you;

32 and now rise by night, you and the people with you, and lie in ambush in the field,

33 and it shall be in the morning, as the sun rises, rise early and spread out against the city, and behold, he and the people with him will come out to you, and you shall do to him whatever your hand finds.

34 And Abimelech and all the people with him rose by night and lay in ambush against Sychem in four companies.

35 And Gaal son of Iobel went out and stood by the door of the city gate, and Abimelech and the people with him rose from the ambush.

36 And Gaal son of Iobel saw the people and said to Zeboul, Behold, people are coming down from the mountain tops. And Zeboul said to him, You are seeing the shadow of the mountains as men.

37 And Gaal continued to speak and said, Behold, people are coming down toward the sea from near the navel of the land, and another company is coming by the road of Elonmaonenim.

38 And Zeboul said to him, And where is your mouth with which you said, Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him? Is this not the people whom you despised? Go out now, please, and fight him.

39 And Gaal went out before the men of Sychem and fought Abimelech.

40 And Abimelech pursued him, and he fled from him; and many wounded fell as far as the door of the gate.

41 And Abimelech entered Arema; and Zeboul drove out Gaal and his brothers so that they would not dwell in Sychem.

42 And it happened on the next day that the people went out into the field, and it was reported to Abimelech.

43 And he took the people and divided them into three companies and lay in ambush in the field; and he saw, and behold, the people came out of the city, and he rose against them and struck them.

44 And Abimelech and the leaders with him spread out and stood by the door of the city gate, and the two companies spread out against all those in the field and struck them.

45 And Abimelech fought in the city all that day and took the city and killed the people in it and tore down the city and sowed it with salt.

46 And all the men of the towers of Sychem heard and came to the assembly of Baithelberith.

47 And it was reported to Abimelech that all the men of the towers of Sychem had gathered.

48 And Abimelech and all the people with him went up Mount Hermon, and Abimelech took the axes in his hand and cut a branch of a tree and lifted it and set it on his shoulders and said to the people with him, What you have seen me doing, do quickly as I did.

49 And every man likewise cut a branch and went after Abimelech and put them against the assembly and set fire to the assembly over them; and all the men of the tower of Sikimoi died too, about a thousand men and women.

50 And Abimelech went from Baithelberith and encamped at Thebes and took it.

51 And a strong tower was in the middle of the city, and all the men and women of the city fled there and shut it from outside themselves and went up onto the roof of the tower.

52 And Abimelech came as far as the tower, and they drew up against him; and Abimelech approached as far as the tower door to burn it with fire.

53 And one woman threw a piece of an upper millstone onto Abimelech's head and broke his skull.

54 And he quickly called to the young man carrying his equipment and said to him, Draw my sword and put me to death, lest they say, A woman killed him. And his young man pierced him through, and he died.

55 And the men of Israel saw that Abimelech had died, and they went, each man to his place.

56 And God returned upon Abimelech the evil that he did to his father by killing his seventy brothers.

57 And God returned all the evil of the men of Sychem upon their heads, and the curse of Ioathan son of Ierobaal came upon them.

Chapter 10

1 And after Abimelech Thola son of Phoua, son of his father's brother, a man of Issachar, arose to save Israel, and he dwelt in Samir in the hill country of Ephraim.

2 And he judged Israel twenty-three years and died and was buried in Samir.

3 And after him Iair the Galaadite arose and judged Israel twenty-two years.

4 And he had thirty-two sons riding on thirty-two colts; and they had thirty-two cities, and they called them the Hamlets of Iair to this day in the land of Galaad.

5 And Iair died and was buried in Ramnon.

6 And the sons of Israel continued to do evil before the Lord and served the Baals and the Astaroths and the gods of Arad and the gods of Sidon and the gods of Moab and the gods of the sons of Ammon and the gods of the Philistines and abandoned the Lord and did not serve him.

7 And the Lord became angry with wrath against Israel and gave them over into the hand of the Philistines and into the hand of the sons of Ammon.

8 And they oppressed and crushed the sons of Israel at that time for eighteen years, all the sons of Israel beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorite in Galaad.

9 And the sons of Ammon crossed the Jordan to fight against Judah and Benjamin and Ephraim, and Israel was greatly oppressed.

10 And the sons of Israel cried out to the Lord, saying, We sinned against you, for we abandoned God and served the Baals.

11 And the Lord said to the sons of Israel, Did I not save you from Egypt and from the Amorite and from the sons of Ammon and from the Philistines

12 and the Sidonians and Amalek and Madiam, who oppressed you, when you cried out to me, and I saved you from their hand?

13 And you abandoned me and served other gods; therefore I will no longer save you.

14 Go and cry out to the gods whom you chose for yourselves, and let them save you in the time of your affliction.

15 And the sons of Israel said to the Lord, We sinned; do to us according to all that is good in your eyes, only rescue us on this day.

16 And they put aside the foreign gods from their midst and served the Lord alone, and his soul was shortened by Israel's toil.

17 And the sons of Ammon came up and encamped in Galaad, and the sons of Israel gathered and encamped in the lookout place.

18 And the people, the rulers of Galaad, said to one another, Who is the man who will begin to fight against the sons of Ammon? He shall be ruler over all who dwell in Galaad.

Chapter 11

1 And Iephthae the Galaadite was exalted in strength; and he was the son of a prostitute, who bore Iephthae to Galaad.

2 And Galaad's wife bore him sons; and the sons of the wife grew up and drove out Iephthae and said to him, You shall not inherit in our father's house, for you are a son of a companion woman.

3 And Iephthae fled from his brothers and dwelt in the land of Tob, and empty men gathered to Iephthae and went out with him.

5 And it happened when the sons of Ammon fought against Israel that the elders of Galaad went to take Iephthae from the land of Tob

6 and said to Iephthae, Come and be our leader, and let us fight against the sons of Ammon.

7 And Iephthae said to the elders of Galaad, Was it not you who hated me and drove me from my father's house and sent me away from you? And why have you come to me now when you have need?

8 And the elders of Galaad said to Iephthae, For this reason we have now returned to you, and you shall go with us and fight against the sons of Ammon; and you shall be ruler for us, over all who dwell in Galaad.

9 And Iephthae said to the elders of Galaad, If you bring me back to fight against the sons of Ammon and the Lord delivers them before me, then I shall be ruler for you.

10 And the elders of Galaad said to Iephthae, Let the Lord be hearing between us if we do not act thus according to your word.

11 And Iephthae went with the elders of Galaad, and the people set him over them as head and leader. And Iephthae spoke all his words before the Lord in Massepha.

12 And Iephthae sent messengers to the king of the sons of Ammon, saying, What is there between me and you, that you came against me to fight in my land?

13 And the king of the sons of Ammon said to Iephthae's messengers, Because Israel took my land when he came up from Egypt, from Arnon as far as Iabok and as far as the Jordan; and now return those lands in peace, and I will go.

14 And Iephthae continued and sent messengers again to the king of the sons of Ammon

15 and said to him, Thus says Iephthae: Israel did not take the land of Moab or the land of the sons of Ammon.

16 For when they came up from Egypt, Israel traveled in the wilderness as far as the Sea of Siph and came to Kades.

17 And Israel sent messengers to the king of Edom, saying, Let me pass, please, through your land; and the king of Edom did not listen. And he sent to the king of Moab, and he did not consent. And Israel dwelt in Kades.

18 And he traveled in the wilderness and went around the land of Edom and the land of Moab and came from the east to the land of Moab and encamped beyond Arnon and did not enter the borders of Moab, for Arnon was the border of Moab.

19 And Israel sent messengers to Seon king of the Amorite, king of Esebon, and Israel said to him, Let us pass, please, through your land to our place.

20 And Seon did not trust Israel to pass through his territory; and Seon gathered all his people, and they encamped at Iasa, and he fought against Israel.

21 And the Lord God of Israel delivered Seon and all his people into the hand of Israel, and he struck him; and Israel inherited all the land of the Amorite who dwelt in that land,

22 from Arnon as far as Iabok and from the wilderness as far as the Jordan.

23 And now the Lord God of Israel has removed the Amorite from before his people Israel, and will you inherit him?

24 Will you not inherit whatever Chamos your god causes you to inherit? And all those whom the Lord our God has removed from before us, we shall inherit them.

25 And now are you in goodness better than Balak son of Sepphor, king of Moab? Did he contend in contention with Israel, or wage war against him in war?

26 During the three hundred years of dwelling in Esebon and its borders and in the land of Aroer and its borders and in all the cities along the Jordan, why did you not rescue them at that time?

27 And now I have not sinned against you, and you do evil to me by fighting against me; let the Lord, the judge, judge today between the sons of Israel and the sons of Ammon.

28 And the king of the sons of Ammon did not listen to the words of Iephthae which he sent to him.

29 And the spirit of the Lord came upon Iephthae, and he passed through Galaad and Manasse and passed through the lookout place of Galaad to the far side of the sons of Ammon.

30 And Iephthae vowed a vow to the Lord and said, If you indeed give the sons of Ammon into my hand,

31 then whoever comes out, who comes out from the door of my house to meet me when I return in peace from the sons of Ammon, shall be for the Lord; I shall offer him as a whole burnt offering.

32 And Iephthae passed over to the sons of Ammon to fight them, and the Lord delivered them into his hand.

33 And he struck them from Aroer as far as Arnon, twenty cities in number, and as far as Ebelcharmin with a very great blow, and the sons of Ammon were brought low before the sons of Israel.

34 And Iephthae came to his house in Massepha, and behold, his daughter was coming out to meet him with tambourines and dances; and she was an only child, and he had no other son or daughter.

35 And it happened when he saw her that he tore his garments and said, Ah, ah, my daughter, with trouble you have troubled me, and you were in my trouble, and I have opened my mouth against you to the Lord and cannot turn back.

36 And she said to him, Father, you opened your mouth to the Lord; do to me as it came out of your mouth, since the Lord has wrought vengeance for you upon your enemies, the sons of Ammon.

37 And she said this to her father: Let my father do this thing, please; leave me two months, and I will go and descend upon the mountains and weep over my virginity, I and my companions.

38 And he said, Go; and he sent her away for two months. And she went, she and her companions, and wept over her virginity upon the mountains.

39 And it happened at the end of the two months that she returned to her father, and he did to her his vow that he had vowed; and she had not known a man. And it became a statute in Israel:

40 from days to days the daughters of Israel went to lament the daughter of Iephthae of Galaad for four days in the year.

Chapter 12

1 And the men of Ephraim were summoned and crossed to the north and said to Iephthae, Why did you cross to fight against the sons of Ammon and not call us to go with you? We shall burn your house over you with fire.

2 And Iephthae said to them, I and my people were men of battle, and the sons of Ammon greatly so; and I called you, and you did not save me from their hand.

3 And I saw that you were no savior, and I put my life in my hand and crossed to the sons of Ammon, and the Lord gave them into my hand; and why did you come up against me on this day to fight me?

4 And Iephthae gathered all the men of Galaad and fought Ephraim, and the men of Galaad struck Ephraim, because they said, You are the escaped ones of Ephraim, Galaad in the midst of Ephraim and in the midst of Manasse.

5 And Galaad seized beforehand the crossings of the Jordan belonging to Ephraim, and the escaped ones of Ephraim said to them, Let us cross, and the men of Galaad said to them, Are you an Ephrathite? And he said, No.

6 And they said to him, Say, please, Stachys; and he did not manage to say it thus. And they seized him and slaughtered him by the crossings of the Jordan, and forty-two thousand of Ephraim fell at that time.

7 And Iephthae judged Israel sixty years. And Iephthae the Galaadite died and was buried in his city in Galaad.

8 And after him Abaisan from Bethlehem judged Israel.

9 And he had thirty sons and thirty daughters whom he sent outside, and he brought thirty daughters from outside for his sons. And he judged Israel seven years.

10 And Abaisan died and was buried in Bethlehem.

11 And after him Ailom the Zabulonite judged Israel ten years.

12 And Ailom the Zabulonite died and was buried in Ailom in the land of Zabulon.

13 And after him Abdon son of Ellel the Pharathonite judged Israel.

14 And he had forty sons and thirty sons of sons, riding on seventy colts. And he judged Israel eight years.

15 And Abdon son of Ellel the Pharathonite died and was buried in Pharathom in the land of Ephraim, in the hill country of Amalek.

Chapter 13

1 And the sons of Israel continued to do evil before the Lord, and the Lord delivered them into the hand of the Philistines for forty years.

2 And there was one man from Saraa, from a district of the kin of Dan, and his name was Manoe, and his wife was barren and had not borne.

3 And an angel of the Lord appeared to the woman and said to her, Behold, you are barren and have not borne; and you shall conceive a son.

4 And now take care, please, and do not drink wine or strong drink and do not eat anything unclean;

5 for behold, you have in your womb and shall bear a son, and iron shall not come up upon his head, for the child shall be a nazir of God from the womb, and he shall begin to save Israel from the hand of the Philistines.

6 And the woman went in and said to her husband, saying, A man of God came to me, and his appearance was like the appearance of an angel of God, very fearsome; and I did not ask him where he was from, and he did not tell me his name.

7 And he said to me, Behold, you have in your womb and shall bear a son; and now do not drink wine or strong drink and do not eat anything unclean, for the child shall be holy to God from the womb until the day of his death.

8 And Manoe prayed to the Lord and said, In me, Lord Adonaie, let the man of God whom you sent come again to us, please, and instruct us what we shall do for the child being born.

9 And God listened to the voice of Manoe, and the angel of God came again to the woman, and she sat in the field, and Manoe her husband was not with her.

10 And the woman hurried and ran and reported to her husband and said to him, Behold, the man who came to me on that day has appeared to me.

11 And Manoe rose and went after his wife and came to the man and said to him, Are you the man who spoke to the woman? And the angel said, I am.

12 And Manoe said, Now your word will come; what shall be the judgment of the child and his deeds?

13 And the angel of the Lord said to Manoe, From all that I have said to the woman she shall keep herself;

14 she shall not eat of anything that comes forth from the vine of wine, and she shall not drink wine or sikera, strong drink, and shall not eat anything unclean; everything that I commanded her she shall keep.

15 And Manoe said to the angel of the Lord, Let us keep you here and prepare a kid of the goats before you.

16 And the angel of the Lord said to Manoe, If you keep me, I shall not eat of your bread, and if you make a whole burnt offering, to the Lord you shall offer it; for Manoe did not know that he was an angel of the Lord.

17 And Manoe said to the angel of the Lord, What is your name? For when your word comes, we shall glorify you.

18 And the angel of the Lord said to him, Why do you ask this, my name? It is wondrous.

19 And Manoe took the kid of the goats and the sacrifice and offered it upon the rock to the Lord; and he made a distinction to act, while Manoe and his wife watched.

20 And it happened as the flame rose above the altar toward heaven that the angel of the Lord went up in the flame of the altar, and Manoe and his wife were watching and fell on their faces to the ground.

21 And the angel of the Lord did not again appear to Manoe and his wife; then Manoe knew that this was an angel of the Lord.

22 And Manoe said to his wife, By death we shall die, for we have seen God.

23 And his wife said to him, If the Lord wished to put us to death, he would not have taken from our hand a whole burnt offering and sacrifice, nor would he have shown us all these things, and at this time he would not have caused us to hear these things.

24 And the woman bore a son and called his name Sampson; and the child grew up, and the Lord blessed him.

25 And the spirit of the Lord began to go out together with him in the camp of Dan, between Saraa and Esthaol.

Chapter 14

1 And Sampson went down to Thamnatha and saw a woman in Thamnatha from the daughters of the foreigners.

2 And he went up and told his father and mother and said, I have seen a woman in Thamnatha from the daughters of the Philistines, and now take her for me as wife.

3 And his father and mother said to him, Are there no daughters among your brothers and among all my people, that you go to take a wife from the uncircumcised foreigners? And Sampson said to his father, Take this one for me, for she is right in my eyes.

4 And his father and mother did not know that this was from the Lord, for he was seeking vengeance from the foreigners; and at that time the foreigners ruled in Israel.

5 And Sampson and his father and mother went down to Thamnatha. And he came as far as the vineyard of Thamnatha, and behold, a young lion roared to meet him;

6 and the spirit of the Lord leaped upon him, and he tore it apart as one would tear apart a kid, and nothing was in his hands. And he did not tell his father and mother what he had done.

7 And they went down and spoke to the woman, and she was right in Sampson's eyes.

8 And after days he returned to take her and turned aside to see the carcass of the lion, and behold, a gathering of bees in the mouth of the lion and honey.

9 And he took it out into his hands and went along, walking and eating; and he went to his father and mother and gave them some, and they ate; and he did not tell them that he took the honey out of the lion's mouth.

10 And his father went down to the woman; and Sampson held a feast there for seven days, for thus the young men do.

11 And it happened when they saw him that they took thirty invited men, and they were with him.

12 And Sampson said to them, I shall pose a riddle to you; if you indeed tell it within the seven days of the feast and find it, I shall give you thirty linen cloths and thirty sets of garments;

13 but if you cannot tell it to me, you shall give me thirty linen cloths and thirty changing sets of garments. And they said to him, Pose the riddle, and we shall hear it.

14 And he said to them, What edible thing came forth from an eater, and what sweet thing from a strong one? And they could not tell the riddle for three days.

15 And it happened on the fourth day that they said to Sampson's wife, Deceive your husband, please, and let him tell you the riddle, lest we burn you and your father's house with fire; have you called us to extort us?

16 And Sampson's wife wept to him and said, Indeed, you have hated me and have not loved me, for you have not told me the riddle that you posed to the sons of my people. And Sampson said to her, If I have not told my father and mother, shall I tell you?

17 And she wept to him through the seven days that their feast lasted; and it happened on the seventh day that he told her, for she pressed him; and she told the sons of her people.

18 And the men of the city said to him on the seventh day before the sun rose, What is sweeter than honey, and what is stronger than a lion? And Sampson said to them, If you had not plowed with my heifer, you would not have known my riddle.

19 And the spirit of the Lord leaped upon him, and he went down to Ascalon and struck thirty men from among them and took their garments and gave the sets to those who had told the riddle. And Sampson became angry with wrath and went up to his father's house.

20 And Sampson's wife became the wife of one of his friends whom he had befriended.

Chapter 15

1 And it happened after days, in the days of the wheat harvest, that Sampson visited his wife with a kid of the goats and said, I shall go in to my wife in the chamber; and her father did not allow him to enter.

2 And her father said, I said, saying, that you surely hated her, and I gave her to one of your friends; is not her younger sister better than she? Let her be yours instead of her.

3 And Sampson said to them, I have been made innocent even this once regarding the foreigners, for I shall do evil to them.

4 And Sampson went and caught three hundred foxes and took torches and turned tail toward tail and put one torch between two tails and bound them;

5 and he lit fire in the torches and sent them into the grain of the foreigners, and they burned from the threshing floor as far as standing grain and as far as vineyard and olive tree.

6 And the foreigners said, Who did these things? And they said, Sampson, the son-in-law of the Thamnite, because he took his wife and gave her to one of his friends; and the foreigners came up and burned her and her father with fire.

7 And Sampson said to them, If you do this, then surely I shall take vengeance on you, and at last I shall cease.

8 And he struck them shin upon thigh with a great blow; and he went down and dwelt in a hole of the rock of Etam.

9 And the foreigners came up and encamped in Judah and spread out in Leui.

10 And the men of Judah said, Why have you come up against us? And the foreigners said, We have come up to bind Sampson and do to him as he did to us.

11 And three thousand men from Judah went down to the hole in the rock of Etam and said to Sampson, Do you not know that the foreigners rule us, and what is this you have done to us? And Sampson said to them, As they did to me, so I did to them.

12 And they said to him, We have come down to bind you, to give you into the hand of the foreigners. And Sampson said to them, Swear to me that you yourselves will not fall upon me.

13 And they said to him, saying, No, for we shall only bind you with a bond and hand you over into their hand, and we shall certainly not put you to death; and they bound him with two new cords and brought him up from that rock.

14 And they came as far as Siagon; and the foreigners shouted and ran to meet him; and the spirit of the Lord leaped upon him, and the cords on his arms became like tow burned in fire, and his bonds melted from his hands.

15 And he found a discarded jawbone of a donkey and stretched out his hand and took it and struck a thousand men with it.

16 And Sampson said, With a donkey's jawbone, wiping out, I wiped them out, for with the donkey's jawbone I struck a thousand men.

17 And it happened when he ceased speaking that he threw the jawbone from his hand; and he called that place Removal of the Jawbone.

18 And he became very thirsty; and he cried to the Lord and said, You favored this great salvation by the hand of your servant, and now I shall die of thirst and fall into the hand of the uncircumcised.

19 And God split the hollow in the jawbone, and water came out of it, and he drank, and his spirit returned and he lived. Therefore its name was called Spring of the One Calling, which is in Siagon to this day. –

20 And he judged Israel in the days of the foreigners twenty years.

Chapter 16

1 And Sampson went to Gaza; and he saw a prostitute there and went in to her.

2 And it was reported to the Gazites, saying, Sampson has come here. And they surrounded him and lay in ambush for him all night at the city gate and kept silent all night, saying, Until dawn breaks, and let us kill him.

3 And Sampson slept until midnight; and he rose in the middle of the night and seized the doors of the city gate with the two posts and lifted them with the bar and set them on his shoulders and went up to the summit of the mountain facing Chebron and set them there.

4 And it happened after this that he loved a woman in Alsorech, and her name was Dalida.

5 And the rulers of the foreigners went up to her and said to her, Deceive him and see wherein his great strength lies and by what means we shall be able to prevail over him and bind him to humble him, and we shall each give you one thousand one hundred pieces of silver.

6 And Dalida said to Sampson, Tell me, please, wherein your great strength lies and by what means you could be bound so that you might be humbled.

7 And Sampson said to her, If they bind me with seven fresh sinews that have not been spoiled, then I shall grow weak and be like one of the people.

8 And the rulers of the foreigners brought her seven fresh sinews that had not been spoiled, and she bound him with them;

9 and an ambush for her sat in the chamber; and she said to him, Foreigners upon you, Sampson! And he tore apart the sinews as someone might break a strand of tow when it smells fire; and his strength was not known.

10 And Dalida said to Sampson, Behold, you have deceived me and spoken lies to me; now therefore tell me by what means you could be bound.

11 And he said to her, If they bind me securely with new cords with which no work has been done, then I shall grow weak and be like one of the people.

12 And Dalida took new cords and bound him with them; and the ambush came out of the chamber; and she said, Foreigners upon you, Sampson! And he tore them from his arms like a little rope.

13 And Dalida said to Sampson, Behold, you have deceived me and spoken lies to me; tell me, please, by what means you could be bound. And he said to her, If you weave the seven locks of my head with the web and hammer them with the peg into the wall, then I shall be weak like one of the people.

14 And it happened while he slept that Dalida took the seven locks of his head and wove them in the web and fixed it with the peg into the wall and said, Foreigners upon you, Sampson! And he awoke from his sleep and pulled the peg of the woven fabric from the wall.

15 And Dalida said to Sampson, How do you say, I love you, when your heart is not with me? This third time you have deceived me and not told me wherein your great strength lies.

16 And it happened as she pressed him with her words all the days and distressed him that he became faint of soul to the point of death;

17 and he told her all his heart and said to her, Iron has not come up upon my head, for I am holy to God from my mother's womb; if then I am shaved, my strength will depart from me, and I shall grow weak and be like all people.

18 And Dalida saw that he had told her all his heart, and sent and summoned the rulers of the foreigners, saying, Come up yet this once, for he has told me all his heart; and the rulers of the foreigners came up to her and brought the silver in their hands.

19 And Dalida made Sampson sleep upon her knees; and she called a man, and he shaved the seven locks of his head; and she began to humble him, and his strength departed from him.

20 And Dalida said, Foreigners upon you, Sampson. And he awoke from his sleep and said, I shall go out as time and again and shake myself free; and he did not know that the Lord had departed from upon him.

21 And the foreigners seized him and gouged out his eyes; and they brought him down to Gaza and bound him with bronze fetters, and he was grinding in the prison house.

22 And the hair of his head began to sprout after it had been shaved.

23 And the rulers of the foreigners gathered to sacrifice a great sacrifice to Dagon their god and to rejoice, and said, God has given Sampson our enemy into our hand.

24 And the people saw him and praised their god, for, Our god has delivered our enemy into our hand, the one who devastated our land and multiplied our wounded.

25 And when their heart became glad, they said, Call Sampson from the guardhouse, and let him play before us. And they called Sampson from the prison house, and he played before them, and they slapped him and stood him between the pillars.

26 And Sampson said to the young man holding his hand, Let me go and I shall feel the pillars upon which the house stands and lean upon them.

27 And the house was full of men and women, and all the rulers of the foreigners were there, and upon the roof were about seven hundred men and women watching Sampson's games.

28 And Sampson cried to the Lord and said, Adonaie Lord, remember me now, please, and strengthen me yet this once, God, and I shall repay one repayment for my two eyes to the foreigners.

29 And Sampson embraced the two pillars of the house on which the house stood, and leaned upon them and grasped one with his right hand and one with his left.

30 And Sampson said, Let my soul die with the foreigners; and he bore down with strength, and the house fell upon the rulers and upon all the people in it; and the dead whom Sampson put to death in his death were more than those he put to death in his life.

31 And his brothers and his father's house came down and took him and went up and buried him between Saraa and Esthaol in the tomb of Manoe his father. And he judged Israel twenty years.

Chapter 17

1 And there was a man from the hill country of Ephraim, and his name was Michaias.

2 And he said to his mother, The one thousand one hundred pieces of silver that you took for yourself and about which you cursed me and spoke in my ears: behold, the silver is with me; I took it. And his mother said, Blessed is my son to the Lord.

3 And he returned the one thousand one hundred pieces of silver to his mother; and his mother said, Consecrating, I have consecrated the silver to the Lord from my hand for my son to make a carved and a cast image, and now I shall return it to you.

4 And he returned the silver to his mother; and his mother took two hundred pieces of silver and gave it to a silversmith, and he made it into a carved and a cast image; and it was in the house of Michaias.

5 And the house of Michaias was for him a house of God; and he made an ephod and theraphin and filled the hand of one of his sons, and he became his priest. –

6 And in those days there was no king in Israel; each man did what was right in his own eyes.

7 And there was a young man from Bethlehem of the district of Judah, and he was a Levite and sojourned there.

8 And the man went from Bethlehem, the city of Judah, to sojourn wherever he might find a place, and came as far as the hill country of Ephraim and as far as the house of Michaias to make his way.

9 And Michaias said to him, Where do you come from? And he said to him, I am a Levite from Bethlehem of Judah, and I am going to sojourn wherever I may find a place.

10 And Michaias said to him, Sit with me and be a father and a priest to me, and I shall give you ten pieces of silver per day and a set of garments and what is needed for your living. And the Levite went

11 and began to sojourn with the man, and the young man became to him like one of his sons.

12 And Michaias filled the hand of the Levite, and he became his priest and was in the house of Michaias.

13 And Michaias said, Now I know that the Lord will do good to me, for the Levite has become my priest.

Chapter 18

1 In those days there was no king in Israel. And in those days the tribe of Dan sought for itself an inheritance to dwell in, for until that day no inheritance had fallen to it among the tribes of Israel.

2 And the sons of Dan sent from their districts five men, sons of strength, from Saraa and Esthaol to examine the land and trace it out, and said to them, Go and trace out the land. And they came as far as the hill country of Ephraim, as far as the house of Michaias, and lodged there.

3 They were at the house of Michaias, and they recognized the voice of the young Levite and turned aside there and said to him, Who brought you here, and what are you doing in this place, and what do you have here?

4 And he said to them, Thus and thus Michaias did for me and hired me, and I became his priest.

5 And they said to him, Inquire, please, by God, and we shall know whether our way in which we travel will prosper.

6 And the priest said to them, Go in peace; before the Lord is your way in which you travel.

7 And the five men went and came to Laisa; and they saw the people within it dwelling in confidence, like the judgment of the Sidonians at rest, and there is no one turning aside or shaming a word in the land, an heir pressing treasure out, and they are far from the Sidonians and have no dealings with any person.

8 And the five men came to their brothers in Saraa and Esthaol and said to their brothers, Why do you sit?

9 And they said, Rise and let us go up against them, for we have seen the land, and behold, it is very good; and do you remain quiet? Do not hesitate to go and enter to inherit the land.

10 And when you come, you will enter to a people in confidence, and the land is broad, for God has given it into your hand, a place where there is no lack of any thing in the land.

11 And six hundred men from the districts of Dan set out from there, from Saraa and Esthaol, girded with implements of battle.

12 And they went up and encamped in Kariathiarim in Judah; therefore that place was called Camp of Dan to this day, behold, behind Kariathiarim.

13 And they passed from there through the hill country of Ephraim and came as far as the house of Michaias.

14 And the five men who had gone to examine the land of Laisa answered and said to their brothers, Do you know that in this house there are an ephod and theraphin and a carved and a cast image? And now know what you will do.

15 And they turned aside there and entered the house of the young Levite, the house of Michaias, and asked him concerning peace.

16 And the six hundred men from the sons of Dan, girded with their implements of battle, stood by the door of the gate.

17 And the five men who had gone to examine the land went up

18 and entered there into the house of Michaias, while the priest stood there; and they took the carved image and the ephod and the theraphin and the cast image. And the priest said to them, What are you doing?

19 And they said to him, Be silent, put your hand on your mouth and come with us and become our father and priest; is it not good for you to be priest of one man's house, or to become priest of a tribe and a house in a district of Israel?

20 And the priest's heart grew glad, and he took the ephod and the theraphin and the carved and the cast image and came among the people.

21 And they turned and went away; and they put the children and the possessions and the baggage before them.

22 They went far from the house of Michaias, and behold, Michaias and the men in the houses by the house of Michaias cried out and caught up with the sons of Dan.

23 And the sons of Dan turned their faces and said to Michaias, What is the matter with you, that you cried out?

24 And Michaias said, You took my carved image which I made, and the priest, and went away; and what do I still have? And why do you say this to me, Why do you cry out?

25 And the sons of Dan said to him, Let your voice not be heard with us, lest men bitter of soul fall upon us and take away your life and the life of your house.

26 And the sons of Dan went on their way; and Michaias saw that they were stronger than he, and returned to his house.

27 And the sons of Dan took what Michaias had made and the priest he had, and came against Laisa, against a people at rest and trusting in confidence, and struck them by the edge of the sword and burned the city with fire;

28 and there was no deliverer, for it was far from the Sidonians, and they had no dealings with anyone, and it was in the valley of the house of Raab. And they built the city and settled in it

29 and called the city's name Dan after the name of Dan their father, who was born to Israel; and Oulamais was the city's name formerly.

30 And the sons of Dan set up the carved image for themselves; and Ionatham son of Gersom son of Manasse, he and his sons, were priests to the tribe of Dan until the day of the exile of the land.

31 And they set up for themselves the carved image which Michaias made all the days that the house of God was in Selom.

Chapter 19

1 And it happened in those days, and there was no king in Israel. And there was a Levite man sojourning in the flanks of the hill country of Ephraim, and he took for himself a woman, a concubine, from Bethlehem of Judah.

2 And his concubine went away from him and departed from him to her father's house in Bethlehem of Judah, and was there days of four months.

3 And her husband rose and went after her to speak to her heart to bring her back to him, with his young man and a pair of donkeys; and she brought him into her father's house, and the father of the young woman saw him and rejoiced to meet him.

4 And his father-in-law, the young woman's father, kept him, and he stayed with him for three days, and they ate and drank and lodged there.

5 And it happened on the fourth day that they rose early in the morning, and he rose to go; and the young woman's father said to his son-in-law, Strengthen your heart with a morsel of bread, and after this you shall go.

6 And he sat, and the two ate together and drank; and the young woman's father said to the man, Come now, lodge here, and your heart will become glad.

7 And the man rose to go; and his father-in-law pressed him, and he sat and lodged there.

8 And he rose early in the morning on the fifth day to go; and the young woman's father said, Strengthen your heart, please, and march until the day declines; and the two ate.

9 And the man rose to go, he and his concubine and his young man; and his father-in-law, the young woman's father, said to him, Behold, please, the day has grown weak toward evening; lodge here, and your heart will become glad, and you shall rise early tomorrow for your way and go to your dwelling.

10 And the man did not consent to lodge and rose and departed and came as far as opposite Iebous [this is Jerusalem], and with him was a pair of saddled donkeys, and his concubine with him.

11 And they came as far as Iebous, and the day had advanced greatly; and the young man said to his master, Come, please, and let us turn aside into this city of the Iebusite and lodge in it.

12 And his master said to him, We shall not turn aside into a foreign city in which none of the sons of Israel are here, and we shall pass on as far as Gabaa.

13 And he said to his young man, Come and let us approach one of the places and lodge in Gabaa or in Rama.

14 And they passed and traveled, and the sun set on them near Gabaa, which belongs to Benjamin.

15 And they turned aside there to enter and lodge in Gabaa; and they entered and sat in the city square, and there was no man taking them into a house to lodge.

16 And behold, an old man was coming from his work in the field in the evening; and the man was from the hill country of Ephraim, and he sojourned in Gabaa, and the men of the place were sons of Benjamin.

17 And he lifted his eyes and saw the traveling man in the city square; and the old man said, Where are you going, and where do you come from?

18 And he said to him, We are passing from Bethlehem of Judah to the flanks of the hill country of Ephraim; I am from there, and I went to Bethlehem of Judah, and I am going to my house, and there is no man taking me into the house;

19 and indeed there is straw and fodder for our donkeys, and bread and wine for me and the maidservant and the young man with your servants; there is no lack of anything.

20 And the old man said, Peace to you, only let all your lack be upon me; only you shall certainly not lodge in the square.

21 And he brought him into his house and made a place for the donkeys, and they washed their feet and ate and drank.

22 And as they gladdened their hearts, behold, men of the city, sons of lawless men, surrounded the house, knocking at the door, and said to the old man, the master of the house, saying, Bring out the man who entered your house so that we may know him.

23 And the man, master of the house, went out to them and said, No, brothers, please do not do evil; after this man has entered my house, do not do this folly;

24 behold, my virgin daughter and his concubine; I shall bring them out, and humble them and do to them what is good in your eyes; but to this man you shall not do this thing of folly.

25 And the men did not consent to listen to him. And the man seized his concubine and brought her out to them outside, and they knew her and abused her all night until morning; and they sent her away as morning rose.

26 And the woman came toward dawn and fell by the door of the house where her husband was, until daylight.

27 And her husband rose in the morning and opened the doors of the house and went out to go on his way, and behold, the woman, his concubine, had fallen beside the doors of the house, with her hands on the threshold.

28 And he said to her, Rise and let us go; and she did not answer, for she was dead. And he put her upon the donkey and went to his place.

29 And he took the sword and seized his concubine and cut her into twelve pieces and sent them throughout all the territory of Israel.

30 And it happened that everyone who saw it said, Such a thing has neither happened nor been seen from the day the sons of Israel came up from the land of Egypt until this day; set counsel for yourselves upon it and speak.

Chapter 20

1 And all the sons of Israel went out, and the assembly was convened as one man, from Dan to Bersabee and the land of Galaad, to the Lord at Massepha.

2 And all the tribes of Israel stood before the Lord in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen drawing a sword.

3 And the sons of Benjamin heard that the sons of Israel had gone up to Massepha. And the sons of Israel came and said, Tell where this evil happened.

4 And the Levite man, the husband of the murdered woman, answered and said, I and my concubine came to Gabaa of Benjamin to lodge.

5 And the men of Gabaa rose against me and surrounded the house against me at night; they wished to murder me, and they humbled my concubine, and she died.

6 And I seized my concubine and cut her into pieces and sent them throughout all the territory of the inheritance of the sons of Israel, for they did an obscene thing and an abomination in Israel.

7 Behold, all of you, sons of Israel, give yourselves a word and counsel there.

8 And all the people rose as one man, saying, No man of us shall go to his dwelling, and no man shall return to his house.

9 And now this is the thing that shall be done to Gabaa: we shall go up against it by lot,

10 but we shall take ten men out of a hundred from all the tribes of Israel, and a hundred out of a thousand and a thousand out of ten thousand, to take provisions so that they can go to Gabaa of Benjamin to do to it according to all the abomination which it did in Israel.

11 And all the men of Israel gathered against the city as one man.

12 And the tribes of Israel sent men throughout the tribe of Benjamin, saying, What is this evil that has happened among you?

13 And now give up the men, sons of lawless men, in Gabaa, and we shall put them to death and cleanse evil from Israel. And the sons of Benjamin did not consent to listen to the voice of their brothers, the sons of Israel.

14 And the sons of Benjamin gathered from their cities to Gabaa to go out to battle against the sons of Israel.

15 And the sons of Benjamin from the cities were counted on that day, twenty-three thousand men drawing a sword, apart from the inhabitants of Gabaa, who were counted, seven hundred chosen men

16 from all the people, right-handed on both sides; all these were slingers of stones at a hair and did not miss.

17 And the men of Israel apart from Benjamin were counted, four hundred thousand men drawing a sword; all these were men of battle.

18 And they rose and went up to Bethel and inquired of God, and the sons of Israel said, Who shall go up first for us to battle against the sons of Benjamin? And the Lord said, Judah shall go up first, leading.

19 And the sons of Israel rose in the morning and encamped against Gabaa.

20 And every man of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin and joined battle with them at Gabaa.

21 And the sons of Benjamin came out from Gabaa and destroyed twenty-two thousand men of Israel upon the ground on that day.

22 And the men of Israel strengthened themselves and continued to join battle in the place where they had joined it on the first day.

23 And the sons of Israel went up and wept before the Lord until evening and inquired of the Lord, saying, Shall we again approach in battle against the sons of Benjamin our brothers? And the Lord said, Go up against them.

24 And the sons of Israel approached the sons of Benjamin on the second day.

25 And the sons of Benjamin came out from Gabaa to meet them on the second day and destroyed a further eighteen thousand men of the sons of Israel upon the ground; all these drew a sword.

26 And all the sons of Israel and all the people went up and came to Bethel and wept and sat there before the Lord and fasted on that day until evening and offered whole burnt offerings and complete offerings before the Lord;

27 for the ark of the covenant of the Lord God was there,

28 and Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron stood before it in those days. And the sons of Israel inquired of the Lord, saying, Shall we again go out to battle against the sons of Benjamin our brothers, or shall we hold back? And the Lord said, Go up, for tomorrow I shall give them into your hands.

29 And the sons of Israel set ambushes around Gabaa.

30 And the sons of Israel went up against the sons of Benjamin on the third day and joined battle against Gabaa as time and again.

31 And the sons of Benjamin came out to meet the people and were drawn away from the city and began to strike wounded men from the people as time and again on the roads, one of which goes up to Bethel and one to Gabaa in the field, about thirty men of Israel.

32 And the sons of Benjamin said, They are falling before us as at first. And the sons of Israel said, Let us flee and draw them away from the city onto the roads; and they did so.

33 And every man rose from his place and joined battle at Baalthamar, and Israel's ambush came from its place from Maaragabe.

34 And ten thousand chosen men from all Israel came opposite Gabaa, and the battle was heavy; and they did not know that evil was overtaking them.

35 And the Lord struck Benjamin before the sons of Israel, and the sons of Israel destroyed from Benjamin on that day twenty-five thousand one hundred men; all these drew a sword.

36 And the sons of Benjamin saw that they were struck; and the men of Israel gave ground to Benjamin, because they trusted in the ambush which they had set against Gabaa.

37 And as they withdrew, the ambush moved and spread out against Gabaa, and the ambush poured out and struck the city by the edge of the sword.

38 And there was a sign for the sons of Israel with the battle ambush: that they should raise a signal of smoke from the city.

39 And the sons of Israel saw that the ambush had seized Gabaa beforehand, and they stood in the battle, and Benjamin began to strike wounded men among the men of Israel, about thirty men, for they said, Again they are surely falling before us as in the first battle.

40 And the signal rose more over the city like a pillar of smoke; and Benjamin looked behind him, and behold, the destruction of the city went up to heaven.

41 And the men of Israel turned back, and the men of Benjamin hurried, for they saw that evil had met them.

42 And they turned before the sons of Israel toward the wilderness road and fled, and the battle overtook them, and those from the cities destroyed them in their midst.

43 And they cut down Benjamin and pursued him from Noua at his heels as far as opposite Gabaa toward the sunrise.

44 And eighteen thousand men of Benjamin fell; all these were men of strength.

45 And the rest turned and fled toward the rock of Remmon in the wilderness, and the sons of Israel gleaned five thousand men from them; and the sons of Israel went down after them as far as Gedan and struck two thousand men from them.

46 And all those who fell from Benjamin on that day were twenty-five thousand men drawing a sword; all these were men of strength.

47 And the rest turned and fled toward the rock of Remmon in the wilderness, six hundred men, and stayed at the rock of Remmon four months.

48 And the sons of Israel turned against the sons of Benjamin and struck them by the edge of the sword, from the city of Methla as far as the livestock and as far as everything found in all the cities; and the cities that were found they burned with fire.

Chapter 21

1 And the sons of Israel swore at Massepha, saying, No man among us shall give his daughter to Benjamin as wife.

2 And the people came to Bethel and sat there until evening before God and raised their voice and wept with great weeping

3 and said, Why, Lord God of Israel, has this happened, for one tribe to be missing today from Israel?

4 And it happened on the next day that the people rose early and built an altar there and offered whole burnt offerings and complete offerings.

5 And the sons of Israel said, Who did not come up in the assembly from all the tribes of Israel to the Lord? For there was a great oath concerning those who had not come up to the Lord at Massepha, saying, He shall certainly be put to death.

6 And the sons of Israel were comforted concerning Benjamin their brother and said, One tribe has been cut off from Israel today;

7 what shall we do for the remaining ones for wives? And we have sworn by the Lord not to give them any of our daughters as wives.

8 And they said, Which one from the tribes of Israel did not go up to the Lord at Massepha? And behold, no man from Iabis Galaad had come to the camp for the assembly.

9 And the people were counted, and no man from the inhabitants of Iabis Galaad was there.

10 And the congregation sent there twelve thousand men from the sons of strength and commanded them, saying, Go and strike the inhabitants of Iabis Galaad by the edge of the sword.

11 And this you shall do: devote to destruction every male and every woman who has known the bed of a male, but preserve the virgins. And they did so.

12 And they found among the inhabitants of Iabis Galaad four hundred young virgin women who had not known a man in the bed of a male, and brought them to the camp at Selon in the land of Canaan.

13 And all the congregation sent and spoke to the sons of Benjamin at the rock of Remmon and called them to peace.

14 And Benjamin returned to the sons of Israel at that time, and the sons of Israel gave them the women whom they had kept alive from the daughters of Iabis Galaad; and thus it pleased them.

15 And the people were comforted concerning Benjamin, for the Lord had made a breach among the tribes of Israel.

16 And the elders of the congregation said, What shall we do for wives for those remaining? For woman has been destroyed from Benjamin.

17 And they said, An inheritance of the escaped ones belongs to Benjamin, and a tribe shall not be wiped out from Israel;

18 for we cannot give them wives from our daughters, for we swore among the sons of Israel, saying, Accursed is he who gives a wife to Benjamin.

19 And they said, Behold, a feast of the Lord is in Selon from days to days, which is north of Bethel, toward sunrise on the road that goes up from Bethel to Sychem and south of Lebona.

20 And they commanded the sons of Benjamin, saying, Go, lie in ambush in the vineyards;

21 and you shall watch, and behold, if the daughters of the inhabitants of Selon come out to dance in the dances, then you shall come out from the vineyards and seize for yourselves each man a wife from the daughters of Selon and go to the land of Benjamin.

22 And it shall be when their fathers or brothers come to plead with you that we shall say to them, Show us mercy regarding them, for we did not take each man his wife in the battle, for you did not give them to them; as at this time you have transgressed.

23 And the sons of Benjamin did so and took wives according to their number from the dancing women whom they seized; and they went and returned to their inheritance and built the cities and dwelt in them.

24 And the sons of Israel went about from there at that time, each man to his tribe and his kin, and they went out from there, each man to his inheritance. –

25 And in those days there was no king in Israel; each man did what was right before him.

Ruth

Chapter 1

1 And it happened when the judges judged that there was a famine in the land, and a man went from Bethlehem of Judah to sojourn in the field of Moab, he and his wife and his sons.

2 And the man's name was Abimelech, and his wife's name Noemin, and the names of his two sons Maalon and Chelaion, Ephrathites from Bethlehem of Judah; and they came to the field of Moab and were there.

3 And Abimelech, Noemin's husband, died, and she and her two sons were left.

4 And they took Moabite women for themselves as wives, the name of one Orpha and the name of the second Ruth; and they dwelt there about ten years.

5 And both Maalon and Chelaion also died, and the woman was left without her husband and her two sons.

6 And she rose, she and her two daughters-in-law, and they returned from the field of Moab, for they had heard in the field of Moab that the Lord had visited his people to give them bread.

7 And she went out from the place where she was, and her two daughters-in-law with her; and they traveled on the road to return to the land of Judah.

8 And Noemin said to her daughters-in-law, Go, please, return each to her mother's house; may the Lord show mercy to you as you showed to the dead and to me;

9 may the Lord grant you that each find rest in her husband's house. And she kissed them, and they raised their voices and wept.

10 And they said to her, With you we return to your people.

11 And Noemin said, Return, please, my daughters; and why do you go with me? Do I still have sons in my womb who will be husbands for you?

12 Return, please, my daughters, for I have grown old so as not to be with a husband; for if I said that I have means to come to be with a husband and bear sons,

13 would you wait for them until they grew up? Or would you be held back for them from coming to be with a husband? No, please, my daughters, for it has become more bitter for me than for you, because the Lord's hand has gone out against me.

14 And they raised their voices and wept again; and Orpha kissed her mother-in-law and returned to her people, but Ruth followed her.

15 And Noemin said to Ruth, Behold, your fellow daughter-in-law has returned to her people and to her gods; return, please, you too, after your fellow daughter-in-law.

16 But Ruth said, Do not confront me to leave you or to turn back from behind you; for wherever you go, I shall go, and wherever you lodge, I shall lodge; your people are my people and your God my God;

17 and wherever you die, I shall die, and there I shall be buried; thus may the Lord do to me and thus may he add, for death shall separate between me and you.

18 And Noemin, seeing that she was determined to go with her, ceased speaking to her further.

19 And both traveled until they came to Bethlehem. And the whole city sounded out over them and said, Is this Noemin?

20 And she said to them, Do not call me Noemin, call me Bitter, for the Sufficient One has made it very bitter for me;

21 I went away full, and the Lord returned me empty; and why do you call me Noemin? The Lord has humbled me, and the Sufficient One has afflicted me.

22 And Noemin returned, and Ruth the Moabite, her daughter-in-law, returning from the field of Moab; and they came to Bethlehem at the beginning of the barley harvest.

Chapter 2

1 And Noemin had a man known to her husband; the man was mighty in strength, from the kin of Abimelech, and his name was Boos.

2 And Ruth the Moabite said to Noemin, Let me go, please, into the field and gather among the ears behind someone in whose eyes I find favor. And she said to her, Go, daughter.

3 And she went and gleaned in the field behind the reapers; and by chance she happened upon the portion of the field of Boos, who was of the kin of Abimelech.

4 And behold, Boos came from Bethlehem and said to the reapers, The Lord be with you; and they said to him, May the Lord bless you.

5 And Boos said to his young man who stood over the reapers, Whose young woman is this?

6 And the young man who stood over the reapers answered and said, She is the Moabite girl who returned with Noemin from the field of Moab

7 and said, Let me glean, please, and gather among the sheaves behind the reapers; and she came and stood from morning until evening, and she rested only a little in the field.

8 And Boos said to Ruth, Have you not heard, daughter? Do not go to glean in another field, and do not go from here; here attach yourself to my young women;

9 let your eyes be on the field where they reap, and go behind them; behold, I have commanded the young men not to touch you; and whenever you thirst, go to the vessels and drink from where the young men draw water.

10 And she fell on her face and bowed to the ground and said to him, Why have I found favor in your eyes that you should recognize me, when I am a foreigner?

11 And Boos answered and said to her, By a report it was reported to me all that you have done for your mother-in-law after your husband died, and how you left your father and mother and the land of your birth and went to a people whom you did not know yesterday or the third day;

12 may the Lord repay your work, and may your wage be full from the Lord God of Israel, to whom you have come to trust under his wings.

13 And she said, May I find favor in your eyes, lord, for you have comforted me and spoken to the heart of your servant, and behold, I shall be like one of your maidservants.

14 And Boos said to her, Already at the hour of eating, come here and eat of the bread and dip your morsel in the vinegar. And Ruth sat beside the reapers, and Boos heaped up parched grain for her, and she ate and was filled and left some.

15 And she rose to glean, and Boos commanded his young men, saying, Let her glean even among the sheaves, and do not shame her;

16 and carrying, carry for her, and also dropping, drop for her from the heaps, and leave it and she will glean, and do not rebuke her.

17 And she gleaned in the field until evening; and she beat out what she had gathered, and it was about an ephah of barley.

18 And she lifted it and entered the city, and her mother-in-law saw what she had gleaned, and Ruth brought out and gave her what she had left from that with which she had been filled.

19 And her mother-in-law said to her, Where did you glean today and where did you work? May the one who recognized you be blessed. And Ruth told her mother-in-law where she had worked and said, The name of the man with whom I worked today is Boos.

20 And Noemin said to her daughter-in-law, Blessed is he to the Lord, for he has not abandoned his mercy with the living and the dead. And Noemin said to her, The man is near to us; he is among those who are near kin to us.

21 And Ruth said to her mother-in-law, Moreover, he said to me, Attach yourself to my young men until they finish all the harvest that belongs to me.

22 And Noemin said to Ruth her daughter-in-law, Good, daughter, that you went with his young women, and they will not meet you in another field.

23 And Ruth attached herself to the young women of Boos to glean until the barley harvest and the wheat harvest were finished. And she dwelt with her mother-in-law.

Chapter 3

1 And Noemin her mother-in-law said to her, Daughter, shall I not seek rest for you, that it may go well with you?

2 And now is not Boos our acquaintance, with whose young women you were? Behold, he winnows the barley threshing floor tonight.

3 And you shall wash and anoint yourself and put your clothing upon yourself and go up to the threshing floor; do not make yourself known to the man until he finishes drinking and eating;

4 and it shall be when he lies down, you shall know the place where he lies, and you shall come and uncover the place by his feet and lie down, and he will tell you what you shall do.

5 And Ruth said to her, Everything that you say, I shall do.

6 And she went down to the threshing floor and did according to everything her mother-in-law commanded her.

7 And Boos ate, and his heart grew glad, and he came to lie down by a part of the heap; and she came secretly and uncovered the place by his feet.

8 And it happened at midnight that the man was startled and disturbed, and behold, a woman was lying by his feet.

9 And he said, Who are you? And she said, I am Ruth your servant, and you shall spread your wing over your servant, for you are a near kinsman.

10 And Boos said, Blessed are you to the Lord God, daughter, for you made your latter mercy better than the first, in that you did not go after young men, whether poor or rich.

11 And now, daughter, do not fear; all that you say I shall do for you, for all the tribe of my people knows that you are a woman of strength,

12 and that I truly am a near kinsman, yet there is a nearer kinsman than I.

13 Lodge tonight, and it shall be in the morning, if he acts as near kin for you, good, let him act as near kin; but if he does not wish to act as near kin for you, I shall act as near kin for you, as the Lord lives; lie down until morning.

14 And she lay by his feet until morning. And she rose before a man could recognize his neighbor; and Boos said, Let it not be known that a woman came to the threshing floor.

15 And he said to her, Bring the wrap that is upon you. And she held it, and he measured six of barley and placed it upon her; and he entered the city.

16 And Ruth entered to her mother-in-law; and she said, Who are you, daughter? And she told her all that the man had done for her.

17 And she said to her, These six of barley he gave me, for he said to me, Do not go in empty to your mother-in-law.

18 And she said, Sit, daughter, until you learn how the matter will fall; for the man shall certainly not rest until he finishes the matter today.

Chapter 4

1 And Boos went up to the gate and sat there, and behold, the near kinsman of whom Boos spoke was passing by. And Boos said to him, Turn aside and sit here, hidden one; and he turned aside and sat.

2 And Boos took ten men from the elders of the city and said, Sit here; and they sat.

3 And Boos said to the near kinsman, The portion of the field that belonged to our brother Abimelech, which has been given to Noemin who returned from the field of Moab,

4 I said, I shall uncover your ear, saying, Acquire it before those sitting and before the elders of my people; if you act as near kin, act as near kin, but if you do not, tell me and I shall know; for there is no one besides you to act as near kin, and I am after you. And he said, I shall act as near kin.

5 And Boos said, On the day you acquire the field from Noemin's hand and from Ruth the Moabite, wife of the dead man, you must acquire her too, so as to raise up the name of the dead man upon his inheritance.

6 And the near kinsman said, I cannot act as near kin for myself, lest I ruin my inheritance; act as near kin for yourself in my near kinship, for I cannot act as near kin.

7 And this was the ordinance formerly in Israel regarding near kinship and regarding exchange to establish every matter: a man would take off his sandal and give it to his neighbor who acted in his near kinship, and this was a witness in Israel.

8 And the near kinsman said to Boos, Acquire my near kinship for yourself; and he took off his sandal and gave it to him.

9 And Boos said to the elders and to all the people, You are witnesses today that I have acquired all that belonged to Abimelech and all that belongs to Chelaion and Maalon from Noemin's hand;

10 and indeed Ruth the Moabite, wife of Maalon, I have acquired for myself as wife, to raise up the dead man's name upon his inheritance, and the dead man's name shall not be destroyed from among his brothers and from the tribe of his people; you are witnesses today.

11 And all the people at the gate said, Witnesses. And the elders said, May the Lord make your wife who comes into your house like Rachel and like Leia, who both built the house of Israel and made strength in Ephratha, and may there be a name in Bethlehem;

12 and may your house become like the house of Phares, whom Thamar bore to Judah, from the seed that the Lord will give you from this maidservant.

13 And Boos took Ruth, and she became his wife, and he went in to her, and the Lord gave her conception, and she bore a son.

14 And the women said to Noemin, Blessed is the Lord, who has not ended your near kinsman today, and may your name be called in Israel,

15 and he shall be for you one who returns your soul and nourishes your old age, for your daughter-in-law who loves you bore him, she who is better to you than seven sons.

16 And Noemin took the child and placed him in her bosom and became a nurse to him.

17 And the neighbor women called him a name, saying, A son has been born to Noemin; and they called his name Obed; he is father of Iessai, father of David.

18 And these are the generations of Phares: Phares fathered Esron,

19 and Esron fathered Arran, and Arran fathered Aminadab,

20 and Aminadab fathered Naasson, and Naasson fathered Salman,

21 and Salman fathered Boos, and Boos fathered Obed,

22 and Obed fathered Iessai, and Iessai fathered David.

1 Samuel

Chapter 1

1 There was a man from Armathaim Sipha, from the hill country of Ephraim, and his name was Elkana son of Ieremeel son of Eliou son of Thoke in Nasib of Ephraim.

2 And he had two wives; the name of one was Anna, and the name of the second Phennana; and Phennana had children, but Anna had no child.

3 And the man went up from days to days from his city, from Armathaim, to worship and sacrifice to the Lord God Sabaoth at Selo; and there were Eli and his two sons Ophni and Phinees, priests of the Lord.

4 And it happened on a day that Elkana sacrificed and gave portions to Phennana his wife and her sons and daughters;

5 and to Anna he gave one portion, for she had no child; nevertheless Elkana loved Anna more than her, and the Lord had shut the parts about her womb;

6 for the Lord had not given her a child according to her affliction and according to the despondency of her affliction, and she was despondent because of this, for the Lord had closed the parts about her womb so as not to give her a child.

7 Thus she did year by year when she went up to the Lord's house; and she was despondent and wept and did not eat.

8 And Elkana her husband said to her, Anna. And she said to him, Behold, I am here, lord. And he said to her, What is the matter with you, that you weep? And why do you not eat? And why does your heart strike you? Am I not better to you than ten children?

9 And Anna rose after they ate in Selo and stood before the Lord, and Eli the priest sat upon the seat by the doorposts of the Lord's temple.

10 And she, pained in soul, prayed to the Lord and wept with weeping

11 and vowed a vow to the Lord, saying, Adonai Lord Eloai Sabaoth, if you indeed look upon the humiliation of your servant and remember me and give your servant male seed, I shall give him before you as a gift until the day of his death, and he shall not drink wine or strong drink, and iron shall not come up upon his head.

12 And it happened while she multiplied her praying before the Lord that Eli the priest watched her mouth;

13 and she spoke in her heart, and her lips moved, but her voice was not heard; and Eli reckoned her drunk.

14 And the young servant of Eli said to her, How long will you be drunk? Remove your wine and go from before the Lord.

15 And Anna answered and said, No, lord; I am a woman for whom the day is hard, and I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, and I pour out my soul before the Lord;

16 do not count your servant a daughter of pestilence, for out of the abundance of my talk I have extended myself until now.

17 And Eli answered and said to her, Go in peace; may the God of Israel give you every request of yours that you have asked of him.

18 And she said, Your servant has found favor in your eyes. And the woman went on her way and entered her lodging and ate with her husband and drank, and her face no longer fell.

19 And they rose early in the morning and worshiped the Lord and went on their way. And Elkana entered his house in Armathaim and knew Anna his wife, and the Lord remembered her,

20 and she conceived. And it happened at the time of days that she bore a son; and she called his name Samuel and said, Because I asked him from the Lord God Sabaoth.

21 And the man Elkana and all his house went up to sacrifice at Selom the sacrifice of the days and his vows and all the tithes of his land;

22 but Anna did not go up with him, for she said to her husband, Until the child goes up, if I wean him, and he shall appear before the Lord's face and remain there forever.

23 And Elkana her husband said to her, Do what is good in your eyes; stay until you wean him; only may the Lord establish what went out from your mouth. And the woman stayed and nursed her son until she weaned him.

24 And she went up with him to Selom with a three-year-old calf and loaves and an ephah of fine flour and a skin of wine and entered the Lord's house at Selom, and the child was with them.

25 And they brought him before the Lord, and his father slaughtered the sacrifice which he made from days to days to the Lord, and brought the child and slaughtered the calf. And Anna the child's mother brought him to Eli

26 and said, In me, lord; as your soul lives, I am the woman who stood before you when praying to the Lord;

27 for this child I prayed, and the Lord gave me my request which I asked of him;

28 and I lend him to the Lord for all the days that he lives, a use for the Lord.

Chapter 2

1 And she said, My heart was strengthened in the Lord, my horn was exalted in my God; my mouth was opened wide against enemies, I rejoiced in your salvation.

2 For there is none holy like the Lord, and none righteous like our God; there is none holy besides you.

3 Do not boast and do not speak lofty things; let no grand speech go out of your mouth, for the Lord is a God of knowledge and a God who prepares his deeds.

4 The bow of mighty ones grew weak, and the weak girded themselves with strength;

5 those full of bread were diminished, and the hungry let land go; for a barren woman bore seven, and she who had many children grew weak.

6 The Lord puts to death and brings to life, brings down to Hades and brings up;

7 the Lord makes poor and makes rich, humbles and raises up.

8 He raises a needy one from the ground and lifts a poor one from a dung heap to seat him with the rulers of peoples, granting them a throne of glory as an inheritance.

9 Giving a vow to one who vows, and he blessed the years of a righteous one; for a man is not strong by strength,

10 the Lord will make his adversary weak, the Lord is holy. Let the wise not boast in his wisdom, and let the mighty not boast in his might, and let the rich not boast in his riches, but let one who boasts boast in this: to understand and know the Lord and to do judgment and righteousness in the midst of the earth. The Lord went up to the heavens and thundered; he will judge the ends of the earth and gives strength to our kings and will exalt the horn of his anointed.

11 And they left him there before the Lord and departed to Armathaim, and the child ministered before the Lord in the presence of Eli the priest.

12 And the sons of Eli the priest were pestilent sons, not knowing the Lord.

13 And the priest's due from the people, from everyone sacrificing: the priest's young man came when the meat was boiled, with a three-pronged meat hook in his hand,

14 and thrust it into the great cauldron or into the bronze vessel or into the pot; whatever came up on the hook the priest took for himself; thus they did to all Israel who came to sacrifice to the Lord at Selom.

15 And before the fat was burned as incense, the priest's young man came and said to the man sacrificing, Give meat to roast for the priest, and I shall certainly not take boiled meat from you out of the cauldron.

16 And the man sacrificing would say, Let the fat first be burned as incense, as is fitting, and take for yourself from everything that your soul desires. And he said, No, for you shall give it now, and if not, I shall take it by force.

17 And the sin of the young men before the Lord was very great, for they rejected the Lord's sacrifice. –

18 And Samuel was ministering before the Lord, a child girded with an ephoud bar,

19 and his mother made him a little double cloak and brought it to him from days to days when she went up with her husband to sacrifice the sacrifice of the days.

20 And Eli blessed Elkana and his wife, saying, May the Lord repay you with seed from this woman in place of the debt which you lent to the Lord. And the man went to his place,

21 and the Lord visited Anna, and she bore three more sons and two daughters. And the child Samuel grew great before the Lord.

22 And Eli was very old; and he heard what his sons were doing to the sons of Israel,

23 and said to them, Why do you do according to this thing which I hear from the mouth of all the Lord's people?

24 No, children, for the report I hear is not good; do not do thus, for the reports I hear, of a people not serving God, are not good.

25 If a man sins against a man, they will pray for him to the Lord; but if he sins against the Lord, who will pray for him? And they did not listen to their father's voice, for the Lord indeed wished to destroy them. –

26 And the child Samuel went on and grew great and was good both with the Lord and with people. –

27 And a man of God came to Eli and said, Thus says the Lord: Revealing myself, I revealed myself to your father's house when they were in the land of Egypt, slaves to Pharaoh's house,

28 and I chose your father's house from all the scepters of Israel to be priest for me and to go up to my altar and burn incense and bear an ephoud, and I gave your father's house all the fire offerings of the sons of Israel for food;

29 and why did you look upon my incense and my sacrifice with a shameless eye and honor your sons above me, to be blessed with the first portion of every sacrifice of Israel before me?

30 Therefore thus said the Lord God of Israel: I said, Your house and your father's house shall walk before me forever; and now the Lord says, By no means for me, for those who honor me I shall honor, and one who despises me shall be dishonored.

31 Behold, days are coming, and I shall destroy your seed and the seed of your father's house,

32 and you shall have no elder in my house all the days;

33 and I shall not destroy a man of yours from my altar, to make his eyes fail and his soul melt away, and all the survivors of your house shall fall by men's sword.

34 And this is the sign for you which shall come upon these two sons of yours, Ophni and Phinees: on one day both shall die.

35 And I shall raise up for myself a faithful priest who will do all that is in my heart and soul; and I shall build him a faithful house, and he shall walk before my anointed all the days.

36 And it shall be that the survivor in your house will come to bow before him for an obol of silver, saying, Cast me into one of your priestly offices to eat bread.

Chapter 3

1 And the child Samuel ministered to the Lord before Eli the priest; and a word of the Lord was precious in those days, and there was no vision making distinctions.

2 And it happened on that day that Eli slept in his place, and his eyes had begun to grow heavy, and he could not see,

3 and before the lamp of God was tended, Samuel slept in the temple where the ark of God was,

4 and the Lord called, Samuel, Samuel; and he said, Behold, I am here.

5 And he ran to Eli and said, Behold, I am here, for you have called me; and he said, I did not call you; return and sleep. And he returned and slept.

6 And the Lord continued and called, Samuel, Samuel; and he went to Eli a second time and said, Behold, I am here, for you have called me; and he said, I did not call you; return and sleep;

7 and Samuel had not yet known God or had a word of the Lord revealed to him.

8 And the Lord continued to call Samuel a third time; and he rose and went to Eli and said, Behold, I am here, for you have called me. And Eli understood that the Lord had called the child,

9 and said, Return and sleep, child, and it shall be if he calls you, say, Speak, Lord, for your servant hears. And Samuel went and lay down in his place.

10 And the Lord came and stood and called him as time and again, and Samuel said, Speak, for your servant hears.

11 And the Lord said to Samuel, Behold, I am doing my words in Israel so that both ears of everyone who hears them will ring.

12 On that day I shall raise up against Eli everything that I spoke concerning his house; I shall begin and finish.

13 And I have told him that I shall exact punishment on his house forever for the injustices of his sons, for his sons spoke evil of God, and he did not admonish them, not even thus.

14 I swore concerning Eli's house: The injustice of Eli's house shall certainly not be atoned for with incense and sacrifices forever.

15 And Samuel slept until morning and rose early in the morning and opened the doors of the Lord's house; and Samuel feared to tell the vision to Eli.

16 And Eli said to Samuel, Samuel, child; and he said, Behold, I am here.

17 And he said, What was the word spoken to you? Do not hide it from me, please; thus may God do to you and thus may he add if you hide from me a word of all the words spoken in your ears.

18 And Samuel told all the words and hid nothing from him, and Eli said, He is the Lord; he will do what is good before him.

19 And Samuel grew great, and the Lord was with him, and none of all his words fell to the ground.

20 And all Israel from Dan to Bersabee knew that Samuel was faithful as a prophet to the Lord.

21 And the Lord continued to reveal himself in Selom, for the Lord was revealed to Samuel; and Samuel was entrusted to become a prophet to the Lord for all Israel from the ends of the land to the ends. And Eli was very old, and his sons went on their way, and their way was evil before the Lord.

Chapter 4

1 And it happened in those days that the foreigners gathered for war against Israel; and Israel went out to meet them in war and encamped by Abenezer, and the foreigners encamped in Aphek.

2 And the foreigners drew up for war against Israel; and the battle turned, and the men of Israel stumbled before the foreigners, and four thousand men were struck in the battle in the field.

3 And the people came to the camp, and the elders of Israel said, Why did the Lord make us stumble today before the foreigners? Let us take the ark of our God from Selom, and let it go out among us and save us from the hand of our enemies.

4 And the people sent to Selom, and they carried from there the ark of the Lord who sits upon cherubim; and both sons of Eli were with the ark, Ophni and Phinees.

5 And it happened when the ark of the Lord came into the camp that all Israel cried out with a loud voice, and the earth sounded.

6 And the foreigners heard the cry and said, What is this great cry in the Hebrews' camp? And they learned that the ark of the Lord had come into the camp.

7 And the foreigners feared and said, These gods have come to them into the camp; woe to us! Deliver us, Lord, today, for such a thing has not happened yesterday or the third day.

8 Woe to us! Who will deliver us from the hand of these strong gods? These are the gods who struck Egypt with every blow and in the wilderness.

9 Be strong and become men, foreigners, lest you serve the Hebrews as they served us; and be men and fight them.

10 And they fought them; and the men of Israel stumbled, and each fled to his dwelling; and there was a very great blow, and thirty thousand of Israel's ranks fell.

11 And the ark of God was taken, and both sons of Eli died, Ophni and Phinees.

12 And a Ieminite man ran from the battle and came to Selom on that day, with his garments torn and earth upon his head.

13 And he came, and behold, Eli sat on the seat by the gate watching the road, for his heart was beside itself concerning the ark of God; and the man entered the city to report, and the city cried out.

14 And Eli heard the sound of the cry and said, What is the cry of this sound? And the man hurried in and reported to Eli.

15 And Eli was a son of ninety years, and his eyes had risen up, and he could not see; and Eli said to the men standing around him, What is the sound of this noise?

16 And the man hurried and approached Eli and said to him, I am the one who has come from the camp, and I fled from the battle today. And he said, What is the thing that happened, child?

17 And the young man answered and said, The men of Israel have fled before the foreigners, and there was a great blow among the people, and both your sons are dead, and the ark of God was taken.

18 And it happened when he mentioned the ark of God that Eli fell backward from the seat near the gate, and his back was broken and he died, for the man was old and heavy; and he had judged Israel twenty years.

19 And his daughter-in-law, Phinees' wife, was pregnant and about to give birth; and she heard the report that the ark of God had been taken and that her father-in-law and husband were dead, and she bent down and gave birth, for her pains turned upon her.

20 And at her time she was dying, and the women standing by her said to her, Do not fear, for you have borne a son; and she did not answer, and her heart did not take notice.

21 And she called the child Ouai Barchaboth because of the ark of God and because of her father-in-law and husband.

22 And they said, The glory of Israel has gone into exile when the ark of the Lord was taken.

Chapter 5

1 And the foreigners took the ark of God and brought it from Abennezer to Azotus.

2 And the foreigners took the ark of the Lord and brought it into the house of Dagon and set it beside Dagon.

3 And the Azotians rose early and entered Dagon's house and saw, and behold, Dagon had fallen on his face before the ark of God; and they raised Dagon and set him in his place. And the Lord's hand grew heavy upon the Azotians and tormented them and struck them in their seats, Azotus and its borders.

4 And it happened when they rose early in the morning that behold, Dagon had fallen on his face before the ark of the Lord's covenant, and Dagon's head and both traces of his hands had been removed to the front of amaphet, each one, and both wrists of his hands had fallen upon the threshold; only Dagon's back was left.

5 For this reason Dagon's priests and everyone entering Dagon's house do not step upon the step of Dagon's house in Azotus to this day, for they step over it. –

6 And the Lord's hand grew heavy upon Azotus, and he brought upon them, and it boiled up for them into the ships, and mice sprang up in the midst of their country, and there was great confusion of death in the city.

7 And the men of Azotus saw that it was thus and said, The ark of the God of Israel shall not remain with us, for his hand is hard upon us and upon Dagon our god.

8 And they sent and gathered the satraps of the foreigners to them and said, What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel? And the Getthites said, Let the ark of God move to us; and the ark of God moved to Gettha.

9 And it happened after it moved that the Lord's hand came upon the city, a very great disturbance, and he struck the men of the city from small to great and struck them in their seats, and the Getthites made seats for themselves.

10 And they sent the ark of God to Ascalon, and it happened when the ark of God entered Ascalon that the Ascalonites cried out, saying, Why did you send the ark of the God of Israel back to us to put us and our people to death?

11 And they sent and gathered the satraps of the foreigners and said, Send away the ark of the God of Israel, and let it settle in its place and it shall certainly not put us and our people to death; for a very heavy confusion of death came upon the whole city when the ark of the God of Israel entered there,

12 and those alive who had not died were struck in their seats, and the cry of the city went up to heaven.

Chapter 6

1 And the ark was in the field of the foreigners seven months, and their land boiled up with mice.

2 And the foreigners called their priests and their diviners and their enchanters, saying, What shall we do with the ark of the Lord? Make known to us with what we shall send it to its place.

3 And they said, If you send away the ark of the covenant of the Lord God of Israel, do not send it away empty, but surely return to it a payment for the torment; then you shall be healed, and atonement shall be made for you, lest his hand fail to depart from you.

4 And they said, What payment for the torment shall we return to it? And they said, According to the number of the satraps of the foreigners, five golden seats, for there is one stumbling for you and your rulers and the people,

5 and golden mice, likenesses of your mice that are destroying the land; and you shall give glory to the Lord, so that he may lighten his hand from upon you and from your gods and from your land.

6 And why do you make your hearts heavy, as Egypt and Pharaoh made their heart heavy? Was it not when he made sport of them that they sent them away and they departed?

7 And now take and make a new wagon and two cows giving birth for the first time, without their offspring, and yoke the cows to the wagon and lead their offspring away from behind them into the house;

8 and you shall take the ark and put it upon the wagon, and the golden objects you shall return to it for the torment and put in a container, bersechthan, beside it, and you shall send it away and drive it away, and it shall depart;

9 and you shall watch: if it travels on the road to its territory toward Baithsamys, he has done this great evil to us; but if not, we shall know that his hand has not touched us, but this has happened to us by chance.

10 And the foreigners did thus and took two cows giving birth for the first time and yoked them to the wagon and held their offspring back in the house

11 and put the ark upon the wagon and the container, ergab, and the golden mice.

12 And the cows went straight on the road toward Baithsamys; they traveled on one path and labored and did not turn to the right or left; and the satraps of the foreigners went after it as far as the territory of Baithsamys.

13 And those in Baithsamys were harvesting the wheat harvest in the valley; and they lifted their eyes and saw the ark of the Lord and rejoiced to meet it.

14 And the wagon entered the field of Osee in Baithsamys, and they stood a great stone there beside it and split the wood of the wagon and offered the cows as a whole burnt offering to the Lord.

15 And the Levites lifted up the ark of the Lord and the container, ergab, with it and the golden objects upon it and set them upon the great stone, and the men of Baithsamys offered whole burnt offerings and sacrifices to the Lord on that day.

16 And the five satraps of the foreigners watched and returned to Ascalon on that day.

17 And these are the golden seats which the foreigners returned to the Lord for the torment: one for Azotus, one for Gaza, one for Ascalon, one for Geth, one for Akkaron.

18 And the golden mice were according to the number of all the cities of the foreigners of the five satraps, from a fortified city to a village of the Pherezite and as far as the great stone upon which they placed the ark of the Lord's covenant, which is in the field of Osee the Baithsamysite.

19 And the sons of Iechonias among the men of Baithsamys did not welcome it, because they saw the ark of the Lord; and he struck among them seventy men and fifty thousand men. And the people mourned, for the Lord had struck among the people a very great blow.

20 And the men from Baithsamys said, Who shall be able to pass before this holy Lord? And to whom shall the ark of the Lord go up from us?

21 And they sent messengers to the inhabitants of Kariathiarim, saying, The foreigners have returned the ark of the Lord; come down and bring it up to yourselves.

Chapter 7

1 And the men of Kariathiarim came and brought up the ark of the Lord's covenant and brought it into the house of Aminadab on the hill; and they consecrated Eleazar his son to guard the ark of the Lord's covenant.

2 And it happened from the day the ark was in Kariathiarim that the days multiplied and became twenty years, and all the house of Israel looked after the Lord.

3 And Samuel said to all the house of Israel, saying, If you are returning to the Lord with all your heart, remove the foreign gods from your midst and the groves and prepare your hearts for the Lord and serve him alone, and he will deliver you from the hand of the foreigners.

4 And the sons of Israel removed the Baals and the groves of Astaroth and served the Lord alone.

5 And Samuel said, Gather all Israel to Massephath, and I shall pray for you to the Lord.

6 And they gathered at Massephath and drew water and poured it on the ground before the Lord and fasted on that day and said, We have sinned before the Lord; and Samuel judged the sons of Israel at Massephath.

7 And the foreigners heard that all the sons of Israel had gathered at Massephath, and the satraps of the foreigners came up against Israel; and the sons of Israel heard and feared before the foreigners.

8 And the sons of Israel said to Samuel, Do not fall silent from us, so as not to cry out to the Lord your God, and he will save us from the hand of the foreigners.

9 And Samuel took one suckling lamb and offered it as a whole burnt offering with all the people to the Lord, and Samuel cried to the Lord for Israel, and the Lord listened to him.

10 And Samuel was offering up the whole burnt offering, and the foreigners approached to wage war against Israel. And the Lord thundered with a great voice on that day against the foreigners, and they were thrown into confusion and stumbled before Israel.

11 And the men of Israel went out from Massephath and pursued the foreigners and struck them as far as below Baithchor.

12 And Samuel took one stone and set it between Massephath and the old place and called its name Abenezer, Stone of the Helper, and said, Thus far the Lord has helped us.

13 And the Lord humbled the foreigners, and they no longer continued to approach the territory of Israel; and the Lord's hand was upon the foreigners all the days of Samuel.

14 And the cities which the foreigners had taken from the sons of Israel were returned, and they returned them to Israel from Ascalon as far as Azob, and they took Israel's territory from the hand of the foreigners. And there was peace between Israel and the Amorite.

15 And Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life;

16 and he went year by year and made a circuit of Bethel and Galgala and Massephath and judged Israel in all these consecrated places,

17 but his return was to Armathaim, for his house was there, and he judged Israel there and built an altar there to the Lord.

Chapter 8

1 And it happened when Samuel grew old that he appointed his sons judges for Israel.

2 And these are the names of his sons: the firstborn Ioel, and the name of the second Abia, judges in Bersabee.

3 And his sons did not walk in his way but turned aside after the completion and took gifts and bent judgments.

4 And the men of Israel gathered and came to Samuel at Armathaim

5 and said to him, Behold, you have grown old, and your sons do not walk in your way; and now appoint a king over us to judge us, as also the remaining nations have.

6 And the thing was evil in Samuel's eyes when they said, Give us a king to judge us; and Samuel prayed to the Lord.

7 And the Lord said to Samuel, Listen to the voice of the people as they speak to you; for they have not despised you, but have despised me, that I should not reign over them.

8 According to all the deeds they have done to me from the day I brought them up from Egypt until this day, and they abandoned me and served other gods, thus they are doing to you also.

9 And now listen to their voice; nevertheless solemnly bear witness to them and tell them the ordinance of the king who shall reign over them.

10 And Samuel spoke every word of the Lord to the people who asked him for a king

11 and said, This shall be the ordinance of the king who shall reign over you: he will take your sons and place them among his chariots and his horsemen and as runners before his chariots,

12 and appoint them for himself as commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, and to reap his harvest and gather his vintage and make his weapons of war and the equipment of his chariots;

13 and he will take your daughters as perfumers and cooks and bakers;

14 and he will take your good fields and your vineyards and your olive groves and give them to his servants;

15 and he will take a tenth of your seed and your vineyards and give it to his eunuchs and his servants;

16 and he will take your male servants and female servants and your good cattle herds and your donkeys and take a tenth for his work,

17 and he will take a tenth of your flocks; and you shall be his servants.

18 And you shall cry out on that day because of your king whom you chose for yourselves, and the Lord will not listen to you in those days, for you chose a king for yourselves.

19 And the people did not wish to listen to Samuel and said to him, No, but a king shall be over us,

20 and we too shall be like all the nations, and our king shall judge us and go out before us and fight our war.

21 And Samuel heard all the words of the people and spoke them in the ears of the Lord.

22 And the Lord said to Samuel, Listen to their voice and make a king reign over them. And Samuel said to the men of Israel, Let each run away to his city.

Chapter 9

1 And there was a man from the sons of Benjamin, and his name was Kis son of Abiel son of Sared son of Bachir son of Aphek son of a Ieminite man, a mighty man.

2 And he had a son, and his name was Saul, of good size, a good man, and there was no one among the sons of Israel better than he, tall above all the land from the shoulders upward.

3 And the donkeys of Kis, Saul's father, were lost, and Kis said to Saul his son, Take one of the young men with you, and rise and go and seek the donkeys.

4 And they passed through the hill country of Ephraim and through the land of Selcha and did not find them; and they passed through the land of Easakem, and they were not there; and they passed through the land of Iakim and did not find them.

5 When they came to Siph, Saul said to his young man who was with him, Come and let us return, lest my father, leaving the donkeys, be concerned about us.

6 And the young man said to him, Behold, a man of God is in this city, and the man is honored; everything he speaks will surely come to pass; and now let us go, so that he may tell us our way upon which we have traveled.

7 And Saul said to his young man who was with him, And behold, we shall go, but what shall we bring to the man of God? For the loaves have run out from our vessels, and there is nothing more with us to bring to the man of God from what we have.

8 And the young man answered Saul further and said, Behold, a quarter shekel of silver has been found in my hand, and you shall give it to the man of God, and he will tell us our way.

9 And formerly in Israel each said thus when going to inquire of God: Come, let us go to the one who sees; for formerly the people called the prophet the one who sees.

10 And Saul said to his young man, The word is good; come and let us go. And they went to the city where the man of God was.

11 As they were going up the ascent to the city, they found young women who had come out to draw water and said to them, Is the one who sees here?

12 And the young women answered them and said to them, He is; behold, he is before you. Now, for today he has come to the city, for there is a sacrifice today for the people at Bama;

13 as you enter the city, so you shall find him in the city before he goes up to Bama to eat, for the people shall certainly not eat until he enters, for he blesses the sacrifice, and after this the guests eat; and now go up, for today you shall find him.

14 And they went up to the city. As they entered the midst of the city, behold, Samuel came out to meet them to go up to Bama.

15 And the Lord had uncovered Samuel's ear one day before Saul came to him, saying,

16 About this time tomorrow I shall send you a man from the land of Benjamin, and you shall anoint him as ruler over my people Israel, and he will save my people from the hand of the foreigners; for I looked upon the humiliation of my people, for their cry has come to me.

17 And Samuel saw Saul; and the Lord answered him, Behold the man of whom I said to you, This one shall rule among my people.

18 And Saul approached Samuel in the midst of the city and said, Tell me, please, which is the house of the one who sees.

19 And Samuel answered Saul and said, I am he; go up before me to Bama and eat with me today, and I shall send you away in the morning and tell you everything in your heart;

20 and concerning your donkeys that have been lost three days today, do not set your heart on them, for they have been found; and for whom are the beautiful things of Israel? Are they not for you and your father's house?

21 And Saul answered and said, Am I not a son of a Ieminite man, of the small scepter of a tribe of Israel, and of the least family of the whole scepter of Benjamin? And why have you spoken to me according to this word?

22 And Samuel took Saul and his young man and led them into the lodging and gave them a place among the first of those invited, about seventy men.

23 And Samuel said to the cook, Give me the portion I gave you, which I told you to place beside you.

24 And the cook lifted up the leg and set it before Saul; and Samuel said to Saul, Behold the remainder; place it before you and eat, for it has been set aside for you as a witness beyond the others; gnaw it off. And Saul ate with Samuel on that day.

25 And he went down from Bama into the city; and they spread a bed for Saul on the roof,

26 and he slept. And it happened as dawn rose that Samuel called Saul on the roof, saying, Rise, and I shall send you away; and Saul rose, and he and Samuel went out as far as outside.

27 As they were going down toward a part of the city, Samuel said to Saul, Tell the young man to pass before us, and you stand still as today and hear a word of God.

Chapter 10

1 And Samuel took the flask of oil and poured it upon his head and kissed him and said to him, Has not the Lord anointed you as ruler over his people, over Israel? And you shall rule among the Lord's people, and you shall save them from the hand of their enemies all around. And this shall be the sign for you that the Lord anointed you as ruler over his inheritance:

2 when you depart from me today, you shall find two men by Rachel's tombs in the territory of Benjamin leaping greatly, and they will say to you, The donkeys which you went to seek have been found, and behold, your father has cast off the matter of the donkeys and has been lavishly concerned for you, saying, What shall I do for my son?

3 And you shall go on from there and arrive at the oak of Thabor and find there three men going up to God at Bethel, one carrying three young goats and one carrying three vessels of bread and one carrying a skin of wine;

4 and they shall ask you the things of peace and give you two first portions of bread, and you shall take them from their hand.

5 And after these things you shall enter the hill of God, where the standing place of the foreigners is, there Nasib the foreigner; and it shall be as you enter the city there that you shall meet a chorus of prophets coming down from Bama, and before them a harp and a tambourine and a flute and a lyre, and they prophesying;

6 and the spirit of the Lord shall leap upon you, and you shall prophesy with them and be turned into another man.

7 And it shall be when these signs come upon you, do whatever your hand finds, for God is with you.

8 And you shall go down before Galgala, and behold, I am coming down to you to offer a whole burnt offering and peace sacrifices; you shall wait seven days until I come to you, and I shall make known to you what you shall do.

9 And it happened when he turned his shoulder to depart from Samuel that God changed for him another heart; and all the signs came on that day.

10 And he came from there to the hill, and behold, a chorus of prophets opposite him; and the spirit of God leaped upon him, and he prophesied among them.

11 And all who knew him yesterday and the third day saw, and behold, he was among the prophets, and the people said, each to his neighbor, What is this that has happened to the son of Kis? Is Saul also among the prophets?

12 And one of them answered and said, And who is his father? Therefore it became a proverb: Is Saul also among the prophets?

13 And he finished prophesying and came to the hill.

14 And his relative said to him and to his young man, Where did you go? And they said, To seek the donkeys; and we saw that they were not there, and we went to Samuel.

15 And the relative said to Saul, Tell me, please, what Samuel said to you.

16 And Saul said to his relative, He indeed told me that the donkeys had been found; but he did not tell him the matter of the kingdom.

17 And Samuel summoned all the people to the Lord at Massepha

18 and said to the sons of Israel, Thus said the Lord God of Israel: I brought the sons of Israel up from Egypt and delivered you from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt and from all the kingdoms that oppressed you;

19 and today you despised God, who himself is your savior from all your evils and afflictions, and said, No, but you shall set a king over us; and now stand before the Lord according to your scepters and according to your tribes.

20 And Samuel brought forward all the scepters of Israel, and the scepter of Benjamin was allotted;

21 and he brought forward the scepter of Benjamin by families, and the family of Mattari was allotted; and they brought forward the family of Mattari by men, and Saul son of Kis was allotted. And they sought him, and he was not found.

22 And Samuel inquired of the Lord again, Has the man come here? And the Lord said, Behold, he is hidden among the equipment.

23 And he ran and took him from there and stood him in the midst of the people, and he stood taller than all the people from the shoulders upward.

24 And Samuel said to all the people, Have you seen the one whom the Lord chose for himself, that there is none like him among you all? And all the people acknowledged it and said, Long live the king.

25 And Samuel told the people the ordinance of the king and wrote it in a book and placed it before the Lord. And Samuel sent all the people away, and each departed to his place.

26 And Saul departed to his house in Gabaa; and sons of might whose hearts the Lord touched went with Saul.

27 And pestilent sons said, How will this one save us? And they dishonored him and brought him no gifts.

Chapter 11

1 And it happened as after a month that Naas the Ammanite went up and encamped against Jabis Galaad. And all the men of Jabis said to Naas the Ammanite, Make a covenant with us, and we will serve you.

2 And Naas the Ammanite said to them, On this condition I will make a covenant with you: by gouging out every right eye of yours; and I will put a reproach upon Israel.

3 And the men of Jabis say to him, Allow us seven days, and we will send messengers into all the territory of Israel; if there is no one to save us, we will come out to you.

4 And the messengers come to Gabaa to Saul and speak the words in the ears of the people, and all the people raised their voice and wept.

5 And behold, Saul was coming from the field after the morning, and Saul said, What is it that the people are weeping? And they recount to him the words of the sons of Jabis.

6 And a spirit of the Lord leaped upon Saul when he heard these words, and his anger was exceedingly kindled against them.

7 And he took two oxen and cut them in pieces and sent them into all the territory of Israel by the hand of messengers, saying, Whoever does not go out after Saul and after Samuel, thus shall they do to his oxen. And a dread of the Lord came upon the people of Israel, and they cried out as one man.

8 And Abiezek musters them in Bama: every man of Israel, six hundred thousand, and the men of Judah, seventy thousand.

9 And he said to the messengers who had come, Thus you shall say to the men of Jabis: Tomorrow salvation shall be yours when the sun has grown hot. And the messengers came into the city and reported to the men of Jabis, and they rejoiced.

10 And the men of Jabis said to Naas the Ammanite, Tomorrow we will come out to you, and you will do to us what is good in your eyes.

11 And it happened on the next day that Saul set the people in three divisions, and they enter the midst of the camp in the morning watch and struck the sons of Ammon until the day grew hot; and it happened that those remaining were scattered, and two of them were not left together.

12 And the people said to Samuel, Who is the one who said that Saul shall not reign over us? Hand over the men, and we will put them to death.

13 And Saul said, No one shall die on this day, because today the Lord has made salvation in Israel.

14 And Samuel said to the people, saying, Let us go to Galgala and renew the kingdom there.

15 And all the people went to Galgala, and Samuel anointed Saul there as king before the Lord in Galgalois and offered sacrifices and peace offerings there before the Lord; and Samuel and all Israel rejoiced exceedingly.

Chapter 12

1 And Samuel said to every man of Israel, Behold, I listened to your voice in all that you said to me, and I made a king reign over you.

2 And now, behold, the king goes about before you, and I have grown old and shall sit down, and my sons, behold, are among you; and I, behold, have gone about before you from my youth until this day.

3 Behold, here I am. Answer against me before the Lord and before his anointed: whose calf have I taken, or whose donkey have I taken, or whom among you have I oppressed, or whom have I pressed hard, or from whose hand have I taken an atonement and a sandal? Answer against me, and I will repay you.

4 And they said to Samuel, You have not wronged us, nor oppressed us, nor crushed us, nor taken anything from anyone's hand.

5 And Samuel said to the people, The Lord is witness among you, and his anointed is witness today on this day that you have found nothing in my hand. And they said, Witness.

6 And Samuel said to the people, saying, The Lord is witness, who made Moses and Aaron, who brought our fathers up from Egypt.

7 And now stand forth, and I will judge you before the Lord and recount to you all the righteousness of the Lord, what he did among you and among your fathers:

8 When Jacob and his sons entered Egypt, and Egypt humbled them, our fathers cried out to the Lord, and the Lord sent Moses and Aaron and brought our fathers out of Egypt and settled them in this place.

9 And they forgot the Lord their God, and he gave them into the hands of Sisara, commander of the army of Jabin king of Asor, and into the hands of the foreigners, and into the hands of the king of Moab, and they fought against them.

10 And they cried out to the Lord and said, We have sinned, because we abandoned the Lord and served the Baalim and the groves; and now deliver us from the hand of our enemies, and we will serve you.

11 And the Lord sent Jerobaal and Barak and Jephthae and Samuel and delivered you from the hand of your enemies round about, and you dwelt in confidence.

12 And you saw that Naas, king of the sons of Ammon, came against you, and you said, No, but a king shall reign over us; and the Lord our God was our king.

13 And now, behold the king whom you chose, and behold, the Lord has given a king over you.

14 If you fear the Lord and serve him and listen to his voice and do not contend with the mouth of the Lord, and both you and the king who reigns over you go after the Lord;

15 but if you do not listen to the voice of the Lord and contend with the mouth of the Lord, then the hand of the Lord shall be upon you and upon your king.

16 And now stand forth and see this great thing that the Lord will do before your eyes.

17 Is it not wheat harvest today? I will call upon the Lord, and he will give thunderings and rain, and you shall know and see that your evil is great, which you did before the Lord in asking a king for yourselves.

18 And Samuel called upon the Lord, and the Lord gave thunderings and rain on that day; and all the people greatly feared the Lord and Samuel.

19 And all the people said to Samuel, Pray for your servants to the Lord your God, that we may not die, because we have added to all our sins an evil in asking a king for ourselves.

20 And Samuel said to the people, Do not fear. You have done all this evil; only do not turn away from following the Lord, and serve the Lord with all your heart,

21 and do not turn aside after the things that are nothing, which accomplish nothing and which do not deliver, because they are nothing.

22 For the Lord will not reject his people for the sake of his great name, because the Lord was pleased to take you to himself as a people.

23 And as for me, may it by no means be that I sin against the Lord by ceasing to pray for you; and I will serve the Lord and show you the good and straight way.

24 Only fear the Lord and serve him in truth and with all your heart, for you have seen what great things he has done with you.

25 And if you do evil with wickedness, both you and your king shall be added.

Chapter 13

1 And Saul chooses for himself three thousand men from the men of Israel, and two thousand were with Saul in Machemas and in the mountain of Bethel,

2 and a thousand were with Jonathan in Gabee of Benjamin, and the remainder of the people he sent away, each to his dwelling.

3 And Jonathan struck the Nasib, the foreigner who was on the hill; and the foreigners hear. And Saul sounds a trumpet throughout all the land, saying, The servants have rebelled.

4 And all Israel heard them saying, Saul has struck the Nasib, the foreigner, and Israel was shamed among the foreigners. And the people cried out after Saul in Galgalois.

5 And the foreigners gather for war against Israel, and come up against Israel: thirty thousand chariots and six thousand horsemen and people like the sand by the sea in multitude; and they come up and encamp in Machemas opposite Baithon toward the south.

6 And a man of Israel saw that it was hard pressed for him not to draw near to him, and the people hid in the caves and in the folds and in the rocks and in the pits and in the cisterns,

7 and those crossing crossed the Jordan into the land of Gad and Galaad. And Saul was still in Galgalois, and all the people were beside themselves following him. –

8 And he waited seven days according to the testimony, as Samuel said, and Samuel did not come to Galgala, and his people were scattered away from him.

9 And Saul said, Bring them near, so that I may make a whole burnt offering and peace offerings; and he offered up the whole burnt offering.

10 And it happened as he finished offering up the whole burnt offering that Samuel arrived; and Saul went out to meet him to bless him.

11 And Samuel said, What have you done? And Saul said, Because I saw that the people had scattered away from me and you did not come, as you appointed, within the testimony of the days, and the foreigners had gathered at Machemas,

12 I said, Now the foreigners will come down against me at Galgala, and I have not entreated the face of the Lord; and I constrained myself and offered up the whole burnt offering.

13 And Samuel said to Saul, It has been made vain for you, because you did not keep my commandment, which the Lord commanded you. For now the Lord would have established your kingdom forever over Israel;

14 but now your kingdom shall not stand, and the Lord will seek for himself a man according to his heart, and the Lord will command him to be ruler over his people, because you did not keep what the Lord commanded you.

15 And Samuel rose and departed from Galgalois on his way. – And the remainder of the people went up after Saul to meet, after the people of war. When they had come from Galgalois to Gabaa of Benjamin, Saul mustered the people found with him, about six hundred men.

16 And Saul and Jonathan his son and the people found with them sat in Gabee of Benjamin and wept, and the foreigners had encamped at Machemas.

17 And a destroyer went out from the camp of the foreigners in three divisions: the one division looking toward the road of Gophera toward the land of Sogal,

18 and the one division looking toward the road of Baithoron, and the one division looking toward the road of Gabee, which bends toward Gai of Sabin.

19 And no smith of iron was found in all the land of Israel, because the foreigners said, Let the Hebrews not make sword and spear.

20 And all Israel would go down into the land of the foreigners to forge, each his harvesting tool and his implement and each his axe and his sickle.

21 And the vintage was ready for harvesting; and the implements were three shekels for the tooth, and for the axe and the sickle the support was the same.

22 And it happened in the days of the war of Machemas that neither sword nor spear was found in the hand of any of the people with Saul and with Jonathan, but one was found for Saul and Jonathan his son.

23 And one went out from the outpost of the foreigners, the one beyond Machemas.

Chapter 14

1 And a day came, and Jonathan son of Saul said to the young man carrying his equipment, Come, and let us cross to the garrison of the foreigners on that far side; and he did not tell his father.

2 And Saul was sitting at the edge of the hill under the pomegranate tree in Magdon, and there were about six hundred men with him;

3 and Achia son of Achitob, brother of Jochabed, son of Phinees, son of Eli, priest of God in Selom, was carrying an ephod. And the people did not know that Jonathan had gone.

4 And between the crossings, where Jonathan sought to cross to the outpost of the foreigners, there was a rocky projection on one side and a rocky projection on the other; the name of the one was Bazes and the name of the other Senna.

5 The one way was from the north for one coming to Machmas, and the other way from the south for one coming to Gabee.

6 And Jonathan said to the young man carrying his equipment, Come, let us cross to the garrison of these uncircumcised, if the Lord might do something for us; for the Lord is not constrained to save by many or by few.

7 And the one carrying his equipment said to him, Do all to which your heart inclines; behold, I am with you, as your heart is my heart.

8 And Jonathan said, Behold, we are crossing to the men and will roll down toward them.

9 If they say thus to us, Stand there until we tell you, then we will stand where we are and will certainly not go up against them;

10 and if they say thus to us, Come up to us, then we will go up, because the Lord has given them into our hands; this shall be the sign for us.

11 And both entered the garrison of the foreigners; and the foreigners say, Behold, the Hebrews are coming out of their holes where they hid.

12 And the men of the garrison answered Jonathan and the one carrying his equipment and say, Come up to us, and we will make a thing known to you. And Jonathan said to the one carrying his equipment, Come up after me, because the Lord has given them into the hands of Israel.

13 And Jonathan went up on his hands and on his feet, and the one carrying his equipment with him; and they looked toward Jonathan's face, and he struck them, and the one carrying his equipment handed them over behind him.

14 And the first blow which Jonathan and the one carrying his equipment struck was about twenty men, among missiles and stone throwers and pebbles of the plain.

15 And there was terror in the camp and in the field, and all the people in the garrison and the destroyers were terrified, and they themselves were unwilling to act; and the land was amazed, and there was terror from the Lord.

16 And Saul's watchmen in Gabee of Benjamin saw, and behold, the camp was in turmoil on this side and that.

17 And Saul said to the people with him, Muster now and see who has gone from you; and they mustered, and behold, Jonathan and the one carrying his equipment were not found.

18 And Saul said to Achia, Bring near the ephod; for he carried the ephod on that day before Israel.

19 And it happened while Saul was speaking to the priest that the sound in the camp of the foreigners went on and increased; and Saul said to the priest, Gather your hands.

20 And Saul and all the people with him cried out and came as far as the battle, and behold, the sword of one man was against his neighbor, a very great confusion.

21 And the servants who had been with the foreigners yesterday and the third day, who had gone up into the camp, turned back to be themselves with the Israelites who were with Saul and Jonathan.

22 And all Israel who were hiding in the mountain of Ephraim also heard that the foreigners had fled, and they too joined after them in battle.

23 And the Lord saved Israel on that day. And the battle passed through Baithon, and all the people with Saul were about ten thousand men; and the battle was scattered through the whole city in the mountain of Ephraim.

24 And Saul committed a great error on that day and put the people under a curse, saying, Cursed is the man who eats bread until evening, and I will avenge myself on my enemy; and none of the people tasted bread.

25 And all the land ate a meal. And Jaar was a forest of bees facing the field,

26 and the people entered the place of bees, and behold, it went along speaking, and behold, no one turned his hand to his mouth, because the people feared the oath of the Lord.

27 And Jonathan had not heard when his father put the people under oath; and he stretched out the end of the staff in his hand and dipped it into the honeycomb and brought his hand back to his mouth, and his eyes looked up.

28 And one of the people answered and said, Your father solemnly put the people under oath, saying, Cursed is the man who eats bread today; and the people were faint.

29 And Jonathan understood and said, My father has troubled the land; see now that my eyes have seen, because I tasted a little of this honey.

30 But if the people had eaten freely today from the spoils of their enemies that they found, surely now the blow among the foreigners would have been greater.

31 And on that day he struck some of the foreigners in Machemas, and the people were exceedingly weary.

32 And the people turned toward the spoils, and the people took flocks and herds and calves and slaughtered them on the ground, and the people ate with the blood.

33 And it was reported to Saul, saying, The people have sinned against the Lord by eating with the blood. And Saul said in Geththem, Roll a large stone here for me.

34 And Saul said, Spread out among the people and tell them to bring here each his calf and each his sheep, and let each slaughter on this, and you shall certainly not sin against the Lord by eating with the blood; and all the people brought, each, what was in his hand and slaughtered there.

35 And Saul built an altar there to the Lord; this was what Saul began to build as an altar to the Lord.

36 And Saul said, Let us go down after the foreigners by night and plunder among them until the day dawns, and let us leave no man among them. And they said, Do whatever is good in your eyes. And the priest said, Let us draw near here to God.

37 And Saul asked God, Shall I go down after the foreigners? Will you give them into the hands of Israel? And he did not answer him on that day.

38 And Saul said, Bring near here all the corners of Israel, and know and see with whom this sin has happened today;

39 for the Lord who saved Israel lives, that even if it answers against Jonathan my son, he shall surely die. And there was no one answering among all the people.

40 And he said to all Israel, You shall be in servitude, and I and Jonathan my son shall be in servitude. And the people said to Saul, Do what is good in your eyes.

41 And Saul said, Lord God of Israel, why have you not answered your servant today? If the wrongdoing is in me or in Jonathan my son, Lord God of Israel, give clear signs; and if you say thus, In your people Israel, then give holiness. And Jonathan and Saul were taken by lot, and the people went out.

42 And Saul said, Cast between me and Jonathan my son; let the one whom the Lord selects by lot die. And the people said to Saul, This word is not so. And Saul prevailed over the people, and they cast between him and Jonathan his son, and Jonathan was taken by lot.

43 And Saul said to Jonathan, Tell me what you have done. And Jonathan told him and said, I tasted a little honey with the end of the staff in my hand; behold, I am dying.

44 And Saul said to him, May God do thus to me and add thus, for you shall surely die today.

45 And the people said to Saul, Shall the one who made this great salvation in Israel be put to death today? As the Lord lives, not a hair of his head shall fall to the ground; for the people of God made this day. And the people prayed for Jonathan on that day, and he did not die. –

46 And Saul went up from pursuing the foreigners, and the foreigners went away to their place.

47 And Saul is allotted a task over Israel. And he fought all his enemies round about: Moab and the sons of Ammon and the sons of Edom and Baitheor and the king of Souba and the foreigners; wherever he turned, he was saved.

48 And he made a force and struck Amalek and delivered Israel from the hand of those trampling him. –

49 And the sons of Saul were Jonathan and Jessiou and Melchisa; and the names of his two daughters: the name of the firstborn was Merob, and the name of the second Melchol;

50 and the name of his wife was Achinoom, daughter of Achimaas. And the name of his commander was Abenner, son of Ner, son of a kinsman of Saul;

51 and Kis, Saul's father, and Ner, Abenner's father, son of Jamin son of Abiel. –

52 And the war against the foreigners was strong all the days of Saul, and Saul saw every mighty man and every man who was a son of might and gathered them to himself.

Chapter 15

1 And Samuel said to Saul, The Lord sent me to anoint you king over Israel, and now hear the voice of the Lord:

2 Thus said the Lord Sabaoth: Now I will avenge what Amalek did to Israel, how he met him on the way as he came up from Egypt;

3 and now go and strike Amalek and Jerim and all that belongs to him, and you shall preserve nothing of his, and you shall destroy him utterly and devote him and all that belongs to him, and you shall not spare him, and you shall kill from man to woman and from infant to suckling and from calf to sheep and from camel to donkey.

4 And Saul gave orders to the people and mustered them in Galgalois, four hundred thousand in companies, and Judah, thirty thousand in companies.

5 And Saul came as far as the cities of Amalek and lay in wait in the torrent bed.

6 And Saul said to the Kenite, Go away and turn aside from the midst of the Amalekite, lest I add you with him, for you showed mercy to the sons of Israel when they came up from Egypt; and the Kenite turned aside from the midst of Amalek.

7 And Saul struck Amalek from Euilat to Sour, facing Egypt.

8 And he captured Agag king of Amalek alive and killed all the people of Jerim by the edge of the sword.

9 And Saul and all the people preserved Agag alive and the good things of the flocks and the herds and the foodstuffs and the vineyards and all the good things, and they did not wish to destroy them utterly; and every work that was dishonored and despised they destroyed utterly.

10 And the word of the Lord came to Samuel, saying,

11 I am grieved that I made Saul king, because he has turned back from following me and has not kept my words. And Samuel was disheartened and cried out to the Lord all night.

12 And Samuel rose early and went to meet Israel in the morning. And it was reported to Samuel, saying, Saul has come to Carmel and has set up a hand for himself and has turned the chariot. And he went down to Galgala to Saul, and behold, he was offering to the Lord as a whole burnt offering the first of the spoils that he had brought from Amalek.

13 And Samuel came to Saul, and Saul said to him, Blessed are you to the Lord; I have established all that the Lord spoke.

14 And Samuel said, And what is this sound of the flock in my ears and the sound of the oxen that I hear?

15 And Saul said, I brought them from Amalek, what the people preserved, the best of the flock and the oxen, so that they might be sacrificed to the Lord your God, and the rest I destroyed utterly.

16 And Samuel said to Saul, Stop, and I will tell you what the Lord spoke to me in the night. And he said to him, Speak.

17 And Samuel said to Saul, Are you not small before him, a leader of the scepter of a tribe of Israel? And the Lord anointed you king over Israel.

18 And the Lord sent you on a way and said to you, Go and destroy utterly those sinning against me, Amalek, and you shall fight them until you finish them.

19 And why did you not listen to the voice of the Lord, but rushed to lay hands on the spoils and did what was evil before the Lord?

20 And Saul said to Samuel, Because I listened to the voice of the people; and I went on the way on which the Lord sent me, and I brought Agag king of Amalek and destroyed Amalek utterly;

21 and the people took from the spoils flocks and herds, the first of what was devoted to destruction, to sacrifice before the Lord our God in Galgalois.

22 And Samuel said, Are whole burnt offerings and sacrifices desired by the Lord as much as listening to the voice of the Lord? Behold, hearing is better than a good sacrifice, and attentive listening better than the fat of rams;

23 for sin is an omen; pain and labors bring teraphim. Because you despised the word of the Lord, the Lord will despise you so that you are not king over Israel.

24 And Saul said to Samuel, I have sinned, because I transgressed the word of the Lord and your saying, because I feared the people and listened to their voice;

25 and now, take away my sin and turn back with me, and I will worship the Lord your God.

26 And Samuel said to Saul, I will not turn back with you, because you despised the word of the Lord, and the Lord will despise you so that you are not king over Israel.

27 And Samuel turned his face to depart. And Saul grasped the edge of his cloak and tore it;

28 and Samuel said to him, The Lord has torn the kingdom of Israel from your hand today and will give it to your neighbor who is better than you;

29 and Israel shall be divided in two, and he will not turn back nor repent, because he is not like a man so as to repent.

30 And Saul said, I have sinned, but honor me now before the elders of Israel and before my people and turn back with me, and I will worship the Lord your God.

31 And Samuel turned back after Saul, and he worshiped the Lord.

32 And Samuel said, Bring Agag king of Amalek to me. And Agag came to him trembling, and Agag said, Is death so bitter?

33 And Samuel said to Agag, As your sword made women childless, so your mother shall be made childless among women. And Samuel slaughtered Agag before the Lord in Galgal.

34 And Samuel departed to Armathaim, and Saul went up to his house in Gabaa.

35 And Samuel did not again see Saul until the day of his death, because Samuel mourned for Saul; and the Lord regretted that he had made Saul king over Israel.

Chapter 16

1 And the Lord said to Samuel, How long do you mourn over Saul, when I have rejected him from reigning over Israel? Fill your horn with oil, and come, I will send you to Jesse as far as Bethlehem, because I have seen among his sons one to reign for me.

2 And Samuel said, How shall I go? Saul will hear and kill me. And the Lord said, Take a heifer of the cattle in your hand, and you shall say, I have come to sacrifice to the Lord;

3 and you shall call Jesse to the sacrifice, and I will make known to you what you shall do, and you shall anoint the one whom I tell you.

4 And Samuel did all that the Lord spoke to him and came to Bethlehem. And the elders of the city were startled at meeting him and said, Is your coming peace, seer?

5 And he said, Peace. I have come to sacrifice to the Lord; sanctify yourselves and rejoice with me today. And he sanctified Jesse and his sons and called them to the sacrifice.

6 And it happened as they entered that he saw Eliab and said, Surely even before the Lord is his anointed.

7 And the Lord said to Samuel, Do not look upon his appearance nor upon the bearing of his stature, because I have rejected him; for God will not see as a man looks, because a man will look at a face, but God will look at a heart.

8 And Jesse called Aminadab, and he passed before Samuel; and he said, The Lord has not chosen this one either.

9 And Jesse brought Sama forward; and he said, The Lord has not chosen this one either.

10 And Jesse brought his seven sons before Samuel; and Samuel said, The Lord has not chosen among these.

11 And Samuel said to Jesse, Have the young men run out? And he said, There is still the little one; behold, he tends the flock. And Samuel said to Jesse, Send and fetch him, because we will certainly not recline until he comes.

12 And he sent and brought him in; and he was ruddy, with beauty of eyes and good in appearance to the Lord; and the Lord said to Samuel, Rise and anoint David, because this one is good.

13 And Samuel took the horn of oil and anointed him in the midst of his brothers, and a spirit of the Lord leaped upon David from that day onward. And Samuel rose and departed to Armathaim.

14 And a spirit of the Lord departed from Saul, and an evil spirit from the Lord choked him.

15 And Saul's servants said to him, Behold now, an evil spirit of the Lord chokes you;

16 let your servants now speak before you and seek for our lord a man who knows how to play on a lyre, and it shall be, when an evil spirit is upon you, that he will play on his lyre, and it shall be good for you, and he will give you rest.

17 And Saul said to his servants, See now for me a man who plays well and bring him to me.

18 And one of his young men answered and said, Behold, I have seen a son of Jesse the Bethlehemite, and he knows a song, and the man is discerning, and the man is a warrior and wise in speech and a man good in appearance, and the Lord is with him.

19 And Saul sent messengers to Jesse, saying, Send to me your son David who is with your flock.

20 And Jesse took a gomor of bread and a skin of wine and one kid of the goats and sent them by the hand of David his son to Saul.

21 And David came to Saul and stood before him; and he loved him greatly, and he became the one carrying his equipment for him.

22 And Saul sent to Jesse, saying, Let David stand before me, because he has found favor in my eyes.

23 And it happened when an evil spirit was upon Saul that David would take the lyre and play with his hand, and Saul would be refreshed, and it would be good for him, and the evil spirit would depart from him.

Chapter 17

1 And the foreigners gather their camps for war and gather at Sokchoth of Judea and encamp between Sokchoth and Azeka in Epheremem.

2 And Saul and the men of Israel gather and encamp in the valley; they draw up for war opposite the foreigners.

3 And the foreigners stand on the mountain here, and Israel stands on the mountain here, and the ravine is between them.

4 And a mighty man came out of the battle line of the foreigners, Goliath was his name, from Geth; his height was four cubits and a span;

5 and a helmet was on his head, and he wore a coat of chain mail, and the weight of his coat was five thousand shekels of bronze and iron;

6 and bronze greaves were above his legs, and a bronze shield was between his shoulders;

7 and the shaft of his spear was like a weaver's beam, and its point was six hundred shekels of iron; and the one carrying his weapons went before him.

8 And he stood and cried out to the battle line of Israel and said to them, Why do you go out to draw up for battle opposite us? Am I not a foreigner and you Hebrews of Saul? Choose a man for yourselves and let him come down to me,

9 and if he is able to fight against me and strikes me, we shall be your servants; but if I am able and strike him, you shall be our servants and serve us.

10 And the foreigner said, Behold, I have reproached the battle line of Israel today on this day; give me a man, and we two shall fight in single combat.

11 And Saul and all Israel heard these words of the foreigner and were astonished and very afraid.

32 And David said to Saul, Let not my lord's heart collapse because of him; your servant will go and fight with this foreigner.

33 And Saul said to David, You will certainly not be able to go against the foreigner to fight with him, for you are a young man, and he is a warrior from his youth.

34 And David said to Saul, Your servant was tending the flock for his father, and whenever the lion and the bear came and took a sheep from the herd,

35 I would go out after him and strike him and snatch it from his mouth; and if he rose against me, I grasped his throat and struck and killed him;

36 and your servant struck the bear and the lion, and the uncircumcised foreigner shall be like one of these; shall I not go and strike him and remove reproach from Israel today? For who is this uncircumcised one who has reproached the battle line of the living God?

37 The Lord who delivered me from the hand of the lion and from the hand of the bear, he will deliver me from the hand of this uncircumcised foreigner. And Saul said to David, Go, and may the Lord be with you.

38 And Saul clothed David with a mantle and a bronze helmet about his head

39 and girded David with his sword over his mantle. And he was wearied after walking once and twice; and David said to Saul, I shall certainly not be able to go in these, because I have not tried them. And they take them off him.

40 And he took his staff in his hand and chose for himself five smooth stones from the torrent bed and placed them in the shepherd's bag that he had for collecting, and his sling was in his hand, and he approached the foreign man.

42 And Goliath saw David and dishonored him, because he was a young man and was ruddy with beauty of eyes.

43 And the foreigner said to David, Am I like a dog, that you come against me with a stick and stones? And David said, No, but worse than a dog. And the foreigner cursed David by his gods.

44 And the foreigner said to David, Come to me, and I will give your flesh to the birds of heaven and the beasts of the earth.

45 And David said to the foreigner, You come to me with sword and spear and shield, but I go to you in the name of the Lord Sabaoth, God of the battle line of Israel, which you have reproached today;

46 and the Lord will shut you into my hand today, and I will kill you and take your head from you and give your limbs and the limbs of the camp of the foreigners on this day to the birds of heaven and the beasts of the earth, and all the earth shall know that there is a God in Israel;

47 and all this assembly shall know that the Lord does not save by sword and spear, because the battle is the Lord's, and the Lord will give you into our hands.

48 And the foreigner rose and went to meet David.

49 And David stretched his hand into the bag and took one stone from there and slung it and struck the foreigner on his forehead, and the stone penetrated through the helmet into his forehead, and he fell on his face to the ground.

51 And David ran and stood over him and took his sword and killed him and took off his head. And the foreigners saw that their mighty man had died, and fled.

52 And the men of Israel and Judah rise and shout and pursue after them as far as the entrance of Geth and as far as the gate of Ascalon, and wounded men of the foreigners fell on the road of the gates and as far as Geth and as far as Akkaron.

53 And the men of Israel returned, turning aside after the foreigners, and trampled their camps.

54 And David took the foreigner's head and brought it to Jerusalem and placed his equipment in his dwelling.

6 And the dancing women came out to meet David from all the cities of Israel with drums and with joy and with cymbals,

7 and the women began and said, Saul struck his thousands and David his ten thousands.

8 And the saying appeared evil in Saul's eyes because of this word, and he said, To David they have given the ten thousands and to me they have given the thousands.

9 And Saul was looking askance at David from that day onward.

12 And Saul was afraid before David

13 and removed him from himself and appointed him a commander of a thousand for himself, and he went out and came in before the people.

14 And David was discerning in all his ways, and the Lord was with him.

15 And Saul saw that he was very discerning and was wary before him.

16 And all Israel and Judah loved David, because he went out and came in before the people.

20 And Melchol the daughter of Saul loved David, and it was reported to Saul, and it was right in his eyes.

21 And Saul said, I will give her to him, and she shall be a snare to him. And the hand of the foreigners was upon Saul;

22 and Saul commanded his servants, saying, Speak secretly to David, saying, Behold, the king delights in you, and all his servants love you, and you, become the king's son-in-law.

23 And Saul's servants spoke these words in David's ears, and David said, Is it a light thing in your eyes to become the king's son-in-law? I am a lowly man and not honored.

24 And Saul's servants reported to him according to these words that David had spoken.

25 And Saul said, Thus you shall say to David: The king does not desire a gift, but a hundred foreskins of the foreigners to take vengeance on the king's enemies. And Saul reckoned to cast him into the hands of the foreigners.

26 And Saul's servants report these words to David, and the word was right in David's eyes, to become the king's son-in-law.

27 And David rose and went, he and his men, and struck a hundred men among the foreigners and brought their foreskins to the king and became the king's son-in-law, and he gave him Melchol his daughter as a wife.

28 And Saul saw that the Lord was with David and all Israel loved him,

29 and he continued to be wary of David still.

Chapter 19

1 And Saul spoke to Jonathan his son and to all his servants to put David to death. And Jonathan son of Saul greatly preferred David,

2 and Jonathan reported to David, saying, Saul seeks to put you to death; therefore guard yourself tomorrow morning and hide and sit in concealment,

3 and I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where you are, and I will speak about you to my father and see what there may be, and I will tell you.

4 And Jonathan spoke good things about David to Saul his father and said to him, Let not the king sin against your servant David, because he has not sinned against you, and his deeds are very good,

5 and he placed his life in his hand and struck the foreigner, and the Lord made a great salvation, and all Israel saw and rejoiced; and why do you sin against innocent blood by putting David to death without cause?

6 And Saul listened to Jonathan's voice, and Saul swore, saying, As the Lord lives, he shall not die.

7 And Jonathan called David and told him all these words, and Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was before him as yesterday and the third day. –

8 And war continued to come against Saul, and David grew strong and fought the foreigners and struck among them a very great blow, and they fled from before him.

9 And an evil spirit of God came upon Saul, and he was in the house sleeping, with a spear in his hand, and David was playing with his hands;

10 and Saul sought to strike David with the spear, and David withdrew from before Saul, and he struck the spear into the wall, and David withdrew and was saved.

11 And it happened on that night that Saul sent messengers to David's house to watch him so as to put him to death in the morning. And Melchol his wife told David, saying, If you do not save your life tonight, tomorrow you will be put to death.

12 And Melchol lowers David through the window, and he went away and fled and was saved.

13 And Melchol took the empty tombs and placed them on the bed, and she placed the liver of the goats at its head and covered them with a garment.

14 And Saul sent messengers to take David, and they say that he is afflicted.

15 And he sends to David, saying, Bring him on the bed to me to put him to death.

16 And the messengers come, and behold, the empty tombs were on the bed, and the liver of the goats at its head.

17 And Saul said to Melchol, Why did you thus deceive me and send away my enemy, so that he was saved? And Melchol said to Saul, He said, Send me away; otherwise I will put you to death.

18 And David fled and was saved and comes to Samuel in Armathaim and tells him all that Saul did to him, and David and Samuel went and sat in Nauath in Rama.

19 And it was reported to Saul, saying, Behold, David is in Nauath in Rama.

20 And Saul sent messengers to take David, and they saw the assembly of the prophets, and Samuel stood appointed over them, and a spirit of God came upon Saul's messengers, and they prophesy.

21 And it was reported to Saul, and he sent other messengers, and they too prophesied. And Saul continued to send messengers a third time, and they too prophesied.

22 And Saul was angered with anger and he too went to Armathaim and came as far as the well of the threshing floor in Sephi and asked and said, Where are Samuel and David? And they said, Behold, in Nauath in Rama.

23 And he went from there to Nauath in Rama, and a spirit of God came upon him too, and he went prophesying until he came to Nauath in Rama.

24 And he took off his garments and prophesied before them and fell naked all that day and all the night; therefore they said, Is Saul also among the prophets?

Chapter 20

1 And David escaped from Nauath in Rama and comes before Jonathan and said, What have I done, and what is my wrongdoing, and how have I sinned before your father that he seeks my life?

2 And Jonathan said to him, By no means for you; you shall certainly not die. Behold, my father will certainly not do a great or small thing and not uncover my ear; and why would my father hide this thing? It is not so.

3 And David answered Jonathan and said, Your father knows well that I have found favor in your eyes, and he said, Let Jonathan not know this, lest he be unwilling; but as the Lord lives and as your soul lives, as I said, it is filled between me and death.

4 And Jonathan said to David, What does your soul desire, and what shall I do for you?

5 And David said to Jonathan, Behold now, tomorrow is a new moon, and I shall certainly not sit with the king to eat, and you shall send me away, and I will hide in the plain until evening.

6 If your father seeks me out, then you shall say, David earnestly asked leave of me to run as far as Bethlehem his city, because there is a sacrifice of the days there for the whole tribe.

7 If he says thus, Good, peace to your servant; but if he answers you harshly, know that the evil has been completed by him.

8 And you shall show mercy to your servant, because you brought your servant into a covenant of the Lord with yourself; and if there is wrongdoing in your servant, put me to death yourself; and why do you thus bring me as far as your father?

9 And Jonathan said, By no means for you; for if I know well that the evil has been completed by my father to come upon you, and if not, to your cities I will report to you.

10 And David said to Jonathan, Who will tell me if your father answers harshly?

11 And Jonathan said to David, Go and stay in the field. And both go out to the field. –

12 And Jonathan said to David, The Lord God of Israel knows that I will examine my father when the time is the third time, and behold, if it is good concerning David, and I do not send to you in the field,

13 may God do thus to Jonathan and add thus, because I will bring the evil to you and uncover your ear and send you away, and you shall depart in peace; and may the Lord be with you as he was with my father.

14 And indeed while I am still living, you shall show mercy to me, and if I surely die,

15 you shall not remove your mercy from my house forever; and if not when the Lord removes David's enemies, each from the face of the earth,

16 may Jonathan's name be removed from David's house, and may the Lord seek out David's enemies.

17 And Jonathan continued further to make David swear, because he loved the soul of the one loving him.

18 And Jonathan said, Tomorrow is the new moon, and you will be sought, because your seat will be sought.

19 And you shall do it a third time and look and come to your place where you hid on the working day, and sit by that Ergab.

20 And I shall shoot a third time with the splinters, casting them toward the Amattari;

21 and behold, I will send the young man, saying, Come, find me the splinter; if I say to the young man, Here is the splinter on this side of you, here, take it, come, because there is peace for you and there is no matter, as the Lord lives;

22 but if I say thus to the young man, Here is the splinter beyond you, go, because the Lord has sent you away.

23 And the word that you and I spoke, behold, the Lord is witness between me and you forever.

24 And David hides in the field, and the month arrives, and the king comes to the table to eat.

25 And the king sat on his seat as once and again, on the seat by the wall, and Jonathan arrived before him, and Abenner sat at Saul's side, and David's place was sought.

26 And Saul said nothing on that day, because he said, An accident appears to have made him unclean, because he has not been purified.

27 And it happened on the following day of the month, on the second day, that David's place was sought, and Saul said to Jonathan his son, Why has the son of Jesse not come to the table either yesterday or today?

28 And Jonathan answered Saul and said to him, David has asked leave of me to go as far as Bethlehem his city

29 and said, Send me away now, because we have a sacrifice of the tribe in the city, and my brothers commanded me, and now if I have found favor in your eyes, I will be saved and see my brothers; for this reason he has not come to the king's table.

30 And Saul was exceedingly angered with Jonathan and said to him, Son of girls who desert, do I not know that you are a partner with the son of Jesse, to your shame and to the shame of the uncovering of your mother?

31 For all the days that the son of Jesse lives on the earth, your kingdom shall not be established; now therefore send and take the young man, because he is a son of death.

32 And Jonathan answered Saul, Why is he to die? What has he done?

33 And Saul raised the spear against Jonathan to put him to death. And Jonathan knew that this evil was completed by his father to put David to death,

34 and Jonathan sprang up from the table in angry rage and did not eat bread on the second day of the month, because he was broken over David, because his father had finished the matter against him.

35 And it happened in the morning that Jonathan went out to the field as he had arranged for the testimony to David, and a small young man was with him.

36 And he said to the young man, Run, find me the splinters that I throw; and the young man ran, and he threw the splinter and sent it past him.

37 And the young man came as far as the place of the splinter that Jonathan had thrown, and Jonathan cried out after the young man and said, There is the splinter beyond you;

38 and Jonathan cried out after his young man, saying, Make haste, hurry and do not stand still; and Jonathan's young man gathered the splinters to his master.

39 And the young man knew nothing; only Jonathan and David knew the matter.

40 And Jonathan gave his equipment to his young man and said to his young man, Go, enter the city.

41 And when the young man entered, David rose from the Ergab and fell on his face and bowed to him three times, and each kissed his neighbor and each wept for his neighbor until a great completion.

42 And Jonathan said, Go in peace, and as we both have sworn in the name of the Lord, saying, The Lord shall be witness between me and you and between my seed and your seed forever.

Chapter 21

1 And David rose and departed, and Jonathan entered the city.

2 And David comes to Nomba to Abimelech the priest. And Abimelech was startled at meeting him and said to him, Why are you alone and no one with you?

3 And David said to the priest, The king has commanded me a thing today and said to me, Let no one know the thing concerning which I send you and concerning which I have commanded you; and to the young men I have borne witness in the place called God's Faithfulness, Phellani Alemoni;

4 and now if there are five loaves under your hand, give into my hand what is found.

5 And the priest answered David and said, There are no common loaves under my hand, but only holy loaves; if the young men have kept themselves from a woman, then he shall eat.

6 And David answered the priest and said to him, But we have abstained from a woman yesterday and the third day; when I went out on the way all the young men became purified, and this way itself is common, because it will be sanctified today through my equipment.

7 And Abimelech the priest gave him the loaves of the presentation, because there was no bread there except the loaves of the face, which had been removed from before the Lord to set out warm bread on the day he took them.

8 And one of Saul's young men was there on that day, detained neessaran before the Lord, and his name was Doek the Syrian, tending Saul's mules.

9 And David said to Abimelech, See if there is here under your hand a spear or sword, because I did not take my sword and the equipment in my hand, because the king's business was urgent.

10 And the priest said, Behold, the sword of Goliath the foreigner, whom you struck in the valley of Ela, and it is wrapped in a garment; if you will take it for yourself, take it, because there is no other besides it here. And David said, Behold, there is none like it; give it to me.

11 And he gave it to him; and David rose and fled on that day from before Saul. And David came to Anchous king of Geth.

12 And Anchous's servants said to him, Is this not David the king of the land? Is it not for him that the dancing women began, saying, Saul struck his thousands and David his ten thousands?

13 And David placed the words in his heart and was very afraid before Anchous king of Geth.

14 And he changed his face before him and pretended on that day and drummed on the city's doors and wandered in his hands and fell upon the doors of the gate, and his spittle flowed down upon his beard.

15 And Anchous said to his servants, Behold, you see an afflicted man; why did you bring him to me?

16 Am I short of afflicted men, that you have brought him in to act afflicted before me? This man shall not enter a house.

Chapter 22

1 And David departed from there and was saved and comes to the cave of Odollam. And his brothers and his father's house hear and go down to him there.

2 And everyone in distress and everyone in debt and everyone pained in soul gathered to him, and he was a leader over them; and there were about four hundred men with him.

3 And David departed from there to Massepha of Moab and said to the king of Moab, Let my father and my mother be with you until I know what God will do for me.

4 And he entreated the face of the king of Moab, and they dwelt with him all the days that David was in the region.

5 And Gad the prophet said to David, Do not sit in the region; go and come to the land of Judah. And David went and came and sat in the city of Sarich.

6 And Saul heard that David and the men with him had become known; and Saul sat on the hill under the field in Rama, with the spear in his hand, and all his servants stood beside him.

7 And Saul said to his servants standing beside him, Hear now, sons of Benjamin; will the son of Jesse really give fields and vineyards to you all and appoint you all commanders of hundreds and commanders of thousands?

8 For all of you have conspired against me, and there is no one who uncovers my ear when my son makes a covenant with the son of Jesse, and there is none among you pained for me and uncovering my ear that my son has stirred up my servant against me as an enemy, as on this day.

9 And Doek the Syrian, appointed over Saul's mules, answered and said, I have seen the son of Jesse coming to Nomba to Abimelech son of Achitob the priest,

10 and he inquired for him through God and gave him provisions and gave him the sword of Goliath the foreigner.

11 And the king sent to call Abimelech son of Achitob and all the sons of his father's house, the priests in Nomba, and they all came to the king.

12 And Saul said, Hear now, son of Achitob. And he said, Behold, I am here; speak, lord.

13 And Saul said to him, Why did you conspire against me, you and the son of Jesse, by giving him bread and sword and inquiring for him through God, to set him against me as an enemy, as on this day?

14 And he answered the king and said, And who among all your servants is faithful like David, the king's son-in-law and ruler of every command of yours and honored in your house?

15 Did I begin today to inquire for him through God? By no means. Let not the king place a charge against his servant and against all my father's house, because your servant knew nothing small or great of all these things.

16 And King Saul said, You shall surely die, Abimelech, you and all your father's house.

17 And the king said to the runners standing over him, Come forward and put the priests of the Lord to death, because their hand is with David, and because they knew that he was fleeing and did not uncover my ear. And the king's servants did not wish to raise their hands to meet the priests of the Lord.

18 And the king said to Doek, Turn yourself and meet the priests. And Doek the Syrian turned and put the priests of the Lord to death on that day, three hundred and five men, all carrying an ephod.

19 And Nomba, the city of the priests, he struck by the edge of the sword, from man to woman, from infant to suckling, and calf and donkey and sheep. –

20 And one son of Abimelech son of Achitob was saved, and his name was Abiathar, and he fled after David.

21 And Abiathar reported to David that Saul had put all the priests of the Lord to death.

22 And David said to Abiathar, I knew on that day that Doek the Syrian would surely report to Saul; I am responsible for the lives of your father's house;

23 stay with me, do not fear, because wherever I seek a place for my life, I will seek one for your life also, for you are protected with me.

Chapter 23

1 And it was reported to David, saying, Behold, the foreigners are fighting in Keila, and they are plundering and trampling the threshing floors.

2 And David inquired through the Lord, saying, Shall I go and strike these foreigners? And the Lord said, Go and strike among these foreigners and save Keila.

3 And David's men said to him, Behold, we are afraid here in Judea, and how will it be if we go to Keila? We shall enter among the spoils of the foreigners.

4 And David continued to inquire again through the Lord, and the Lord answered him and said to him, Rise and go down to Keila, because I am giving the foreigners into your hands.

5 And David and the men with him went to Keila and fought among the foreigners, and they fled before him, and he drove away their livestock and struck a great blow among them, and David saved those dwelling in Keila.

6 And it happened when Abiathar son of Abimelech fled to David that he too went down with David to Keila, having an ephod in his hand.

7 And it was reported to Saul that David had come to Keila, and Saul said, God has sold him into my hands, because he has been shut in by entering a city of doors and bars.

8 And Saul ordered all the people to go down to war at Keila to hem in David and his men.

9 And David knew that Saul was not keeping silent about the evil against him, and David said to Abiathar the priest, Bring near the ephod of the Lord.

10 And David said, Lord God of Israel, your servant has surely heard that Saul seeks to come against Keila to destroy the city because of me.

11 Will he be shut in? And now will Saul come down, as your servant has heard? Lord God of Israel, tell your servant. And the Lord said, He will be shut in.

13 And David and the men with him, about four hundred, rose and went out of Keila and went wherever they went; and it was reported to Saul that David had been saved from Keila, and he ceased going out.

14 And David sat in the wilderness in Maserem in the narrow places and sat in the wilderness on Mount Ziph in the parched land; and Saul sought him all the days, and the Lord did not give him into his hands.

15 And David saw that Saul was going out to seek David; and David was on the parched mountain in Kaine Ziph.

16 And Jonathan son of Saul rose and went to David in Kaine and strengthened his hands in the Lord.

17 And he said to him, Do not fear, for the hand of Saul my father shall certainly not find you, and you shall reign over Israel, and I shall be second to you; and Saul my father knows this.

18 And the two made a covenant before the Lord. And David sat in Kaine, and Jonathan departed to his house.

19 And the Ziphites went up from the parched land to Saul on the hill, saying, Is not David, behold, hiding near us in Messara in the narrow places in Kaine on the hill of Echela to the right of Jessaimoun?

20 And now let all that is in the king's soul for coming down come down to us; they have shut him into the king's hands.

21 And Saul said to them, Blessed are you to the Lord, because you have been pained for me;

22 go now and prepare further and know his place, where his foot will be, swiftly there where you said, lest he act craftily;

23 and see and know, and we will go with you, and it shall be, if he is on the land, I will search him out among all the thousands of Judah.

24 And the Ziphites rose and went before Saul; and David and his men were in the wilderness of Maan toward evening to the right of Jessaimoun.

25 And Saul and his men went to seek him; and they reported it to David, and he went down to the rock in the wilderness of Maan; and Saul heard and pursued after David into the wilderness of Maan.

26 And Saul and his men go on one side of this mountain, and David and his men were on one side of this mountain; and David was sheltering himself to go from before Saul, and Saul and his men encamped against David and his men to seize them.

27 And a messenger came to Saul, saying, Hurry and come, for the foreigners have attacked the land.

28 And Saul turned back from pursuing after David and went to meet the foreigners; therefore that place was called the Divided Rock.

Chapter 24

1 And David went up from there and sat in the narrow places of Engaddi.

2 And it happened when Saul returned from pursuing the foreigners that it was reported to him, saying that David was in the wilderness of Engaddi.

3 And he took with him three thousand chosen men from all Israel and went to seek David and his men facing Sadaiem.

4 And he came to the flocks of sheep by the road, and there was a cave there, and Saul entered to prepare himself; and David and his men were sitting farther inside the cave.

5 And David's men said to him, Behold, this is the day of which the Lord said to you that he would give your enemy into your hands, and you shall do to him as is good in your eyes. And David rose and secretly took off the edge of Saul's cloak.

6 And it happened after this that David's heart struck him, because he had taken off the edge of his cloak,

7 and David said to his men, By no means from the Lord for me, if I do this thing to my lord, the Lord's anointed, to raise my hand against him, because this one is the Lord's anointed;

8 and David persuaded his men with words and did not allow them to rise and put Saul to death. And Saul rose and went down to the road.

9 And David rose after him from the cave, and David cried out after Saul, saying, My lord king; and Saul looked behind him, and David bent his face to the ground and bowed to him.

10 And David said to Saul, Why do you listen to the words of the people saying, Behold, David seeks your life?

11 Behold, on this day your eyes have seen how the Lord gave you into my hand today in the cave, and I did not wish to kill you and I spared you and said, I will not raise my hand against my lord, because this one is the Lord's anointed.

12 And behold, the edge of your cloak is in my hand; I took off the edge and did not kill you. And know and see today that there is no evil in my hand nor impiety nor breach of faith, and I have not sinned against you; and you bind my life to take it.

13 May the Lord judge between me and you, and may the Lord avenge me on you; and my hand shall not be upon you,

14 as the ancient proverb says, From lawless men wrongdoing will come forth; and my hand shall not be upon you.

15 And now after whom do you go out, king of Israel? After whom do you pursue? After a dead dog and after one flea.

16 May the Lord be judge and arbiter between me and you; may the Lord see and judge my case and vindicate me from your hand.

17 And it happened when David finished speaking these words to Saul that Saul said, Is this your voice, child David? And Saul raised his voice and wept.

18 And Saul said to David, You are more righteous than I, because you repaid me good, but I repaid you evil.

19 And you have told me today the good things you did to me, how the Lord shut me into your hands today and you did not kill me;

20 and because if anyone should find his enemy in distress and send him away on a good way, the Lord will repay him good, as you have done today.

21 And now, behold, I know that you shall surely reign and the kingdom of Israel shall stand in your hands.

22 And now swear to me by the Lord that you will not destroy my seed after me and will not obliterate my name from my father's house.

23 And David swore to Saul. And Saul departed to his place, and David and his men went up to the narrow Messara.

Chapter 25

1 And Samuel died, and all Israel gather and mourn him and bury him at his house in Armathaim. – And David rose and went down to the wilderness of Maan.

2 And there was a man in Maan, and his flocks were in Carmel; and the man was very great, and he had three thousand sheep and a thousand goats; and it happened while he was shearing his flock in Carmel.

3 And the man's name was Nabal, and his wife's name was Abigaia; and his wife was good in understanding and very beautiful in appearance, but the man was harsh and evil in his practices, and the man was doglike.

4 And David heard in the wilderness that Nabal the Carmelite was shearing his flock,

5 and David sent ten young men and said to the young men, Go up to Carmel and go to Nabal and ask him in my name for peace

6 and say thus: For seasons; and may you be well, and your house and all yours be well.

7 And now, behold, I have heard that they are shearing for you; now your shepherds who were with us in the wilderness, we did not hinder them and did not demand anything of them all the days they were in Carmel;

8 ask your young men, and they will tell you. And let the young men find favor in your eyes, for we have come on a good day; give now whatever your hand finds to your son David.

9 And the young men come and speak these words to Nabal according to all these sayings in David's name. And he leaped up

10 and Nabal answered David's servants and said, Who is David, and who is Jesse's son? Today the servants departing, each from before his lord, have multiplied.

11 And shall I take my bread and my wine and my slaughtered animals, which I have slaughtered for those shearing my sheep, and give them to men whom I do not know where they are from?

12 And David's young men turned to their way and returned and came and reported these words to David.

13 And David said to his men, Gird on each his sword; and about four hundred men went up after David, and the two hundred sat with the equipment.

14 And one of the young men reported to Abigaia, Nabal's wife, saying, Behold, David sent messengers from the wilderness to bless our lord, and he turned away from them.

15 And the men were very good to us; they did not hinder us nor demand anything of us all the days we were beside them; and while we were in the field

16 they were like a wall around us both night and day all the days we were beside them tending the flock.

17 And now know and see what you will do, because evil has been completed against our lord and his house; and he is a pestilent son, and there is no speaking to him.

18 And Abigaia hurried and took two hundred loaves and two vessels of wine and five prepared sheep and five oiphi of meal and one gomor of raisins and two hundred cakes of pressed fruit and put them on the donkeys

19 and said to her young men, Go on before me, and behold, I am coming after you. And she did not tell her husband.

20 And it happened while she rode on the donkey and went down under cover of the mountain that behold, David and his men were coming down to meet her, and she met them.

21 And David had said, Perhaps I guarded all his things in the wilderness for nothing and we did not demand to take anything from all his things, and he has repaid me evil for good;

22 may God do thus to David and add thus if I leave of all that belongs to Nabal until morning one who urinates against a wall.

23 And Abigaia saw David and hurried and leaped down from the donkey and fell before David on her face and bowed to him to the ground

24 at his feet and said, On me, my lord, be the wrongdoing; let your servant speak in your ears, and hear a word of your servant.

25 Let not my lord set his heart upon this pestilent man, because as his name is, so he is; Nabal is his name, and folly is with him; and I your servant did not see your young men whom you sent.

26 And now, lord, as the Lord lives and as your soul lives, since the Lord has prevented you from coming into innocent blood and saving your hand for yourself, now may your enemies and those seeking evil for my lord become like Nabal.

27 And now take this blessing that your servant has brought to my lord, and you shall give it to the young men standing beside my lord.

28 Take away your servant's lawlessness, for the Lord will surely make my lord a faithful house, because my lord fights the Lord's war, and evil shall never be found in you.

29 And a man will rise pursuing you and seeking your life, and my lord's life shall be bound in the bundle of life with the Lord God, and the life of your enemies you will sling in the midst of the sling.

30 And it shall be that the Lord will do for my lord all the good things that he spoke over you, and the Lord will command you to be leader over Israel,

31 and this shall not be for you an abomination and a stumbling block to my lord, to shed innocent blood without cause and save my lord's hand for himself. And the Lord will do good to my lord, and you shall remember your servant to do good to her.

32 And David said to Abigaia, Blessed be the Lord God of Israel, who sent you today on this occasion to meet me,

33 and blessed be your manner, and blessed are you who prevented me today on this occasion from coming into bloodshed and saving my hand for myself.

34 But as the Lord God of Israel lives, who prevented me today from doing evil to you, if you had not hurried and come to meet me, then I said, If one who urinates against a wall should be left to Nabal until the light of morning.

35 And David took from her hand all she had brought him and said to her, Go up in peace to your house; see, I have listened to your voice and favored your face.

36 And Abigaia came to Nabal, and behold, he had a drinking feast in his house like a king's feast, and Nabal's heart was good upon him, and he was very drunk; and she did not tell him a small or great thing until the light of morning.

37 And it happened in the morning, when Nabal had sobered up from the wine, that his wife told him these things, and his heart died within him, and he became like a stone.

38 And it happened after about ten days that the Lord struck Nabal, and he died.

39 And David heard and said, Blessed be the Lord, who judged the case of my reproach from Nabal's hand and preserved his servant from the hand of evils, and the Lord returned Nabal's evil upon his head. And David sent and spoke about Abigaia to take her for himself as a wife.

40 And David's servants came to Abigaia in Carmel and spoke to her, saying, David sent us to you to take you as a wife for him.

41 And she rose and bowed to the ground on her face and said, Behold, your servant is a maidservant to wash the feet of your servants.

42 And Abigaia rose and mounted the donkey, and five girls followed her, and she went after David's servants and became his wife.

43 And David took Achinaam from Jezrael, and both were his wives.

44 And Saul gave Melchol his daughter, David's wife, to Phalti son of Lais, from Romma.

Chapter 26

1 And the Ziphites come from the parched land to Saul on the hill, saying, Behold, David shelters with us on the hill of Echela facing Jessaimoun.

2 And Saul rose and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, and with him three thousand chosen men from Israel, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph.

3 And Saul encamped on the hill of Echela facing Jessaimoun beside the road, and David sat in the wilderness. And David saw that Saul had come after him into the wilderness,

4 and David sent scouts and learned that Saul had come ready from Keila.

5 And David rose secretly and goes into the place where Saul slept, and there was Abenner son of Ner, his commander, and Saul slept in a covered wagon, and the people were encamped around him.

6 And David answered and said to Achimelech the Chettite and to Abessa son of Sarouia, brother of Joab, saying, Who will enter with me to Saul in the camp? And Abessa said, I will enter with you.

7 And David and Abessa go into the people by night, and behold, Saul was sleeping in sleep in the covered wagon, and the spear was fixed in the ground at his head, and Abenner and his people slept around him.

8 And Abessa said to David, The Lord has shut your enemy into your hands today, and now I will strike him with the spear into the ground once, and I will not do it a second time to him.

9 And David said to Abessa, Do not humble him, for who will raise his hand against the Lord's anointed and be innocent?

10 And David said, As the Lord lives, unless the Lord strikes him, or his day comes and he dies, or he goes down to war and is added;

11 by no means from the Lord for me to raise my hand against the Lord's anointed; and now take the spear from beside his head and the flask of water, and let us depart by ourselves.

12 And David took the spear and the flask of water from beside his head, and they departed by themselves; and no one saw and no one knew and no one awoke, all sleeping, because an astonishment from the Lord had fallen upon them.

13 And David crossed to the far side and stood on the top of the mountain far away, and there was much distance between them.

14 And David called to the people and spoke to Abenner, saying, Will you not answer, Abenner? And Abenner answered and said, Who are you who calls me?

15 And David said to Abenner, Are you not a man? And who is like you in Israel? And why do you not guard your lord the king? For one of the people entered to destroy the king your lord.

16 And this thing you have done is not good; as the Lord lives, you who guard the king your lord, the Lord's anointed, are sons of death. And now look: where are the king's spear and flask of water that were by his head?

17 And Saul recognized David's voice and said, Is this your voice, child David? And David said, Your servant, my lord king.

18 And he said, Why does my lord pursue after his servant thus? For how have I sinned, and what wrongdoing was found in me?

19 And now let my lord the king hear the word of his servant: if God is stirring you up against me, may he smell your sacrifice; but if sons of men, cursed are they before the Lord, because they have driven me out today so that I may not be established in the Lord's inheritance, saying, Go, serve other gods.

20 And now let not my blood fall on the ground opposite the face of the Lord, because the king of Israel has gone out to seek my life, as the night raven pursues in the mountains.

21 And Saul said, I have sinned; return, child David, because I will not do evil to you in return for my life being precious in your eyes today; I have acted vainly and erred very greatly.

22 And David answered and said, Behold, the king's spear; let one of the young men cross and take it.

23 And the Lord will return to each his acts of righteousness and his faithfulness, since the Lord gave you into my hands today and I did not wish to raise my hand against the Lord's anointed;

24 and behold, as your life was magnified in my eyes today, so may my life be magnified before the Lord, and may he shelter me and deliver me from every distress.

25 And Saul said to David, Blessed are you, child, and you shall surely do and being able shall be able. And David departed on his way, and Saul returned to his place.

Chapter 27

1 And David said in his heart, saying, Now on one day I shall be added into Saul's hands, and there is no good for me unless I am saved in the land of the foreigners and Saul ceases seeking me in all Israel's territory, and I shall be saved from his hand.

2 And David rose, and the four hundred men with him, and went to Anchous son of Ammach king of Geth.

3 And David sat with Anchous in Geth, he and his men, each with his household, and David with both his wives, Achinaam the Jezraelite and Abigaia the wife of Nabal the Carmelite.

4 And it was reported to Saul that David had fled to Geth, and he did not continue to seek him.

5 And David said to Anchous, If now your servant has found favor in your eyes, let them give me a place in one of the country towns and I will sit there; and why should your servant sit in a royal city with you?

6 And he gave him Sekelak on that day; therefore Sekelak belonged to the king of Judea until this day.

7 And the number of the days that David sat in the countryside of the foreigners was four months.

8 And David and his men would go up and attack all the Gesiri and the Amalekite; and behold, the land had been inhabited from those belonging to Gelampsour, fortified, as far as the land of Egypt.

9 And he would strike the land and keep no man or woman alive and take flocks and herds and donkeys and camels and clothing, and they returned and came to Anchous.

10 And Anchous said to David, Against whom did you attack today? And David said to Anchous, Against the south of Judea and against the south of Jesmega and against the south of the Kenezi.

11 And he kept no man or woman alive to bring into Geth, saying, Lest they report against us in Geth, saying, Thus David does. And this was his practice all the days that David sat in the countryside of the foreigners.

12 And David was greatly trusted by Anchous, who said, He has certainly become disgraced among his people in Israel and shall be my servant forever.

Chapter 28

1 And it happened in those days that the foreigners gather in their camps to go out to fight with Israel, and Anchous said to David, Know assuredly that you and your men will go out with me to war.

2 And David said to Anchous, Thus now you will know what your servant will do; and Anchous said to David, Thus I shall make you chief bodyguard all the days.

3 And Samuel died, and all Israel mourned him and buried him in Armathaim in his city. And Saul removed the ventriloquists and the knowers from the land.

4 And the foreigners gather and come and encamp at Soman, and Saul gathers every man of Israel and they encamp at Gelboue.

5 And Saul saw the camp of the foreigners and was afraid, and his heart was greatly beside itself.

6 And Saul inquired through the Lord, and the Lord did not answer him in dreams or in clear signs or in the prophets.

7 And Saul said to his servants, Seek for me a woman ventriloquist, and I will go to her and seek through her; and his servants said to him, Behold, a woman ventriloquist is in Aendor.

8 And Saul disguised himself and put on other garments and went, he and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night, and he said to her, Divine for me now through the ventriloquist and bring up for me whomever I tell you.

9 And the woman said to him, Behold now, you know what Saul did, how he destroyed the ventriloquists and the knowers from the land; and why are you setting a snare for my life to put it to death?

10 And Saul swore to her, saying, As the Lord lives, no wrongdoing shall befall you in this matter.

11 And the woman said, Whom shall I bring up for you? And he said, Bring up Samuel for me.

12 And the woman saw Samuel and cried out with a great voice; and the woman said to Saul, Why did you deceive me? You are Saul.

13 And the king said to her, Do not fear; say whom you have seen. And she said to him, I have seen gods coming up from the earth.

14 And he said to her, What did you perceive? And she said to him, An upright man coming up from the earth, and he was clothed with a cloak. And Saul knew that this was Samuel, and bowed his face to the ground and worshiped him.

15 And Samuel said, Why have you troubled me to bring me up? And Saul said, I am greatly distressed, and the foreigners fight against me, and God has departed from me and has no longer listened to me, either by the hand of the prophets or in dreams; and now I have called you to make known to me what I shall do.

16 And Samuel said, Why do you ask me? The Lord has departed from you and has become with your neighbor;

17 and the Lord has done to you as he spoke by my hand, and the Lord will tear your kingdom from your hand and give it to your neighbor David.

18 Because you did not listen to the voice of the Lord and did not enact the heat of his anger in Amalek, for this reason the Lord has done this thing to you on this day.

19 And the Lord will give Israel with you into the hands of the foreigners, and tomorrow you and your sons with you shall fall, and the Lord will give Israel's camp into the hands of the foreigners.

20 And Saul hurried and fell while standing upon the ground and was very afraid because of Samuel's words; and there was no strength left in him, for he had eaten no bread all that day and all that night.

21 And the woman came to Saul and saw that he had hurried greatly, and she said to him, Behold now, your servant listened to your voice and placed my life in my hand and listened to the words you spoke to me;

22 and now listen to the voice of your servant, and I will set before you a morsel of bread, and eat, and there shall be strength in you, because you will go on a way.

23 And he did not wish to eat; and his servants and the woman pressed him, and he listened to their voice and rose from the ground and sat on the stool.

24 And the woman had a pasture-fed heifer in the house, and she hurried and slaughtered it and took flour and kneaded it and baked unleavened bread

25 and brought it before Saul and before his servants, and they ate. And they rose and departed that night.

Chapter 29

1 And the foreigners gather all their camps at Aphek, and Israel encamped in Aendor in Jezrael.

2 And the satraps of the foreigners were passing along in hundreds and thousands, and David and his men were passing along at the rear with Anchous.

3 And the satraps of the foreigners said, Who are these passing along? And Anchous said to the commanders of the foreigners, Is this not David, servant of Saul king of Israel? He has been with us for days, this second year, and I have found nothing in him from the day he fell in with me until this day.

4 And the commanders of the foreigners were grieved over him and say to him, Turn the man back to his place where you appointed him, and let him not come with us to war and not become a plotter against the camp; and by what will this one be reconciled to his lord? Is it not by the heads of those men?

5 Is this not David, for whom they began in dances, saying, Saul struck his thousands and David his ten thousands?

6 And Anchous called David and said to him, As the Lord lives, you are upright and good in my eyes, and your going out and your coming in with me in the camp, and I have found no evil against you from the day you came to me until today; but in the eyes of the satraps you are not good;

7 and now return and go in peace, and you shall certainly not do evil in the eyes of the satraps of the foreigners.

8 And David said to Anchous, What have I done to you, and what have you found in your servant from the day I was before you until this day, that I shall certainly not come to fight the enemies of my lord the king?

9 And Anchous answered David, I know that you are good in my eyes, but the satraps of the foreigners say, He shall not come with us to war.

10 And now rise early in the morning, you and the servants of your lord who came with you, and go to the place where I appointed you, and do not place a pestilent word in your heart, because you are good before me; and rise early on the way, and let it become light for you, and go.

11 And David and his men rose early to depart and guard the land of the foreigners, and the foreigners went up to fight against Israel.

Chapter 30

1 And it happened when David and his men entered Sekelak on the third day that Amalek had attacked the south and Sekelak and struck Sekelak and burned it with fire;

2 and the women and all in it, from small to great, they did not put man or woman to death, but took them captive and departed on their way.

3 And David and his men came to the city, and behold, it had been burned with fire, and their wives and their sons and their daughters had been taken captive.

4 And David and his men raised their voice and wept until there was no strength in them to weep any more.

5 And both David's wives had been taken captive, Achinoom the Jezraelite and Abigaia the wife of Nabal the Carmelite.

6 And David was greatly distressed, because the people spoke of stoning him, because every person's soul was pained, each over his sons and daughters; and David was strengthened in the Lord his God.

7 And David said to Abiathar the priest, son of Achimelech, Bring near the ephod.

8 And David inquired through the Lord, saying, Shall I pursue after this raiding band? Shall I overtake them? And he said to him, Pursue, because you shall surely overtake and shall surely deliver.

9 And David went, he and the six hundred men with him, and they came as far as the torrent bed Bosor, and the remainder stood still.

10 And he pursued with four hundred men, but two hundred men stayed behind, who sat across the torrent bed Bosor.

11 And they find an Egyptian man in the field and take him and bring him to David in the field; and they give him bread, and he ate, and they gave him water to drink;

12 and they give him a piece of a cake of pressed fruit, and he ate, and his spirit was established within him, because he had not eaten bread or drunk water for three days and three nights.

13 And David said to him, Whose are you and where are you from? And the Egyptian young man said, I am a servant of an Amalekite man, and my lord left me because I became ill three days ago today.

14 And we attacked the south of Cholthi and the parts of Judea and the south of Cheloub, and we burned Sekelak with fire.

15 And David said to him, Will you lead me down to this raiding band? And he said, Swear to me by God that you will not put me to death and will not give me into my lord's hands, and I will lead you down to this raiding band.

16 And he led him down there, and behold, they were spread over the face of all the land, eating and drinking and celebrating among all the great spoils that they had taken from the land of the foreigners and from the land of Judah.

17 And David came upon them and struck them from the morning star until evening and the following day, and not one man of them was saved except four hundred young men who had mounted camels and fled.

18 And David took back all that the Amalekites had taken, and he delivered both his wives.

19 And nothing was missing to them from small to great, from the spoils to sons and daughters and everything they had taken from them; David returned it all.

20 And David took all the flocks and herds and drove them before the spoils, and concerning those spoils it was said, These are David's spoils. –

21 And David comes to the two hundred men who were too weak to go after David and whom he had left by the torrent bed Bosor, and they went out to meet David and to meet the people with him, and David approached the people, and they asked him about peace.

22 And every pestilent and evil man among the fighting men who had gone with David answered and said, Because they did not pursue with us, we will not give them from the spoils we delivered, except that each take away his wife and children and return.

23 And David said, You shall not do thus after the Lord has given to us and guarded us and the Lord has given the raiding band that came against us into our hands.

24 And who will listen to these words of yours? For they are not less than you; therefore as the portion of the one going down to war, so shall be the portion of the one sitting by the equipment; they shall divide alike.

25 And it happened from that day onward and became an ordinance and a judgment for Israel until today.

26 And David came to Sekelak and sent from the spoils to the elders of Judah and to his neighbors, saying, Behold, from the spoils of the Lord's enemies;

27 to those in Baithsour and those in Rama of the south and those in Jeththor

28 and those in Aroer and the Ammadi and those in Saphi and those in Esthie

28 and those in Aroer and the Ammadi and those in Saphi and those in Esthie

29 and those in Carmel and those in the cities of Jerameli and those in the cities of Kenezi

30 and those in Jerimouth and those in Bersabee and those in Noo

31 and those in Chebron and all the places through which David had passed there, he and his men.

Chapter 31

1 And the foreigners fought against Israel, and the men of Israel fled from before the foreigners, and wounded men fall on Mount Gelboue.

2 And the foreigners close with Saul and his sons, and the foreigners strike Jonathan and Aminadab and Melchisa, Saul's sons.

3 And the battle grows heavy against Saul, and the javelin throwers, men who were archers, find him, and he was wounded in the region below the ribs.

4 And Saul said to the one carrying his equipment, Draw your sword and pierce me with it, lest these uncircumcised men come and pierce me and mock me. And the one carrying his equipment did not wish to, because he was very afraid; and Saul took the sword and fell upon it.

5 And the one carrying his equipment saw that Saul had died, and he too fell upon his sword and died with him.

6 And Saul and his three sons and the one carrying his equipment died together on that day.

7 And the men of Israel across the valley and across the Jordan saw that the men of Israel had fled and that Saul and his sons had died, and they leave their cities and flee; and the foreigners come and dwell in them. –

8 And it happened on the next day that the foreigners come to strip the dead and find Saul and his three sons fallen on the mountains of Gelboue.

9 And they turn him over and strip off his equipment and send it around the land of the foreigners, announcing good news to their idols and their people;

10 and they dedicated his equipment in the Astarte temple and fastened his body to the wall of Baithsan.

11 And those dwelling in Jabis of Galaad hear what the foreigners had done to Saul.

12 And every man of might rose and went all night and took Saul's body and the body of Jonathan his son from the wall of Baithsan and bring them to Jabis and burn them there.

13 And they take their bones and bury them under the field in Jabis and fast for seven days.

2 Samuel

Chapter 1

1 And it happened after Saul died and David returned from striking Amalek that David sat in Sekelak two days.

2 And it happened on the third day that behold, a man came from the camp, from Saul's people, with his garments torn and earth on his head, and it happened when he entered to David that he fell to the ground and bowed to him.

3 And David said to him, Where do you come from? And he said to him, I have escaped from Israel's camp.

4 And David said to him, What is this matter? Tell me. And he said that the people fled from the battle, and many of the people have fallen and died; and Saul has died also, and Jonathan his son has died.

5 And David said to the young man telling him, How do you know that Saul and Jonathan his son have died?

6 And the young man telling him said, By chance I happened upon Mount Gelboue, and behold, Saul leaned upon his spear, and behold, the chariots and horse commanders closed in upon him.

7 And he looked behind him and saw me and called me, and I said, Behold, I am here.

8 And he said to me, Who are you? And I said, I am an Amalekite.

9 And he said to me, Stand over me now and put me to death, because terrible darkness has seized me, because all my life is in me.

10 And I stood over him and put him to death, because I knew that he would not live after his falling; and I took the royal thing on his head and the bracelet on his arm and have brought them here to my lord.

11 And David grasped his garments and tore them, and all the men with him tore their garments.

12 And they mourned and wept and fasted until evening for Saul and Jonathan his son and for the people of Judah and the house of Israel, because they had been struck by the sword.

13 And David said to the young man telling him, Where are you from? And he said, I am the son of a sojourning Amalekite man.

14 And David said to him, How were you not afraid to raise your hand to destroy the Lord's anointed?

15 And David called one of his young men and said, Come forward and meet him; and he struck him, and he died.

16 And David said to him, Your blood is upon your head, because your mouth answered against you, saying, I put the Lord's anointed to death.

17 And David lamented this lament over Saul and Jonathan his son

18 and said to teach the sons of Judah – behold, it is written in the Book of the Upright –

19 Set up a pillar, Israel, for the dead wounded upon your heights; how the mighty have fallen.

20 Do not tell it in Geth and do not announce good news in the exits of Ascalon, lest the daughters of the foreigners rejoice, lest the daughters of the uncircumcised exult.

21 Mountains in Gelboue, let neither dew nor rain come down upon you, nor fields of first fruits, because there the shield of the mighty was abhorred, Saul's shield was not anointed with oil.

22 From the blood of the wounded, from the fat of the mighty, Jonathan's bow did not turn back empty to the rear, and Saul's sword did not return empty.

23 Saul and Jonathan, the beloved and beautiful, not separated, fair in their life and in their death not divided, swifter than eagles and stronger than lions.

24 Daughters of Israel, weep for Saul, who clothed you in scarlet with your adornment, who placed golden adornment on your garments.

25 How the mighty have fallen in the midst of battle; Jonathan, wounded upon your heights.

26 I grieve over you, my brother Jonathan; you were exceedingly beautiful to me, your love to me was wondrous beyond the love of women.

27 How the mighty have fallen and the implements of war perished.

Chapter 2

1 And it happened after these things that David inquired of the Lord, saying, Shall I go up to one of the cities of Judah? And the Lord said to him, Go up. And David said, Where shall I go up? And he said, To Chebron.

2 And David went up there to Chebron, and both his wives, Achinoom the Jezraelite and Abigaia the wife of Nabal the Carmelite,

3 and the men with him, each with his household, and they dwelt in the cities of Chebron.

4 And men of Judea come and anoint David there to reign over the house of Judah. And they reported to David, saying that the men of Jabis of Galaad buried Saul.

5 And David sent messengers to the leaders of Jabis of Galaad and said to them, Blessed are you to the Lord, because you have done this mercy to your lord, to Saul the Lord's anointed, and buried him and Jonathan his son;

6 and now may the Lord do mercy and truth with you, and I too will do these good things with you, because you did this thing;

7 and now let your hands be strengthened and become mighty sons, because your lord Saul has died, and the house of Judah has also anointed me king over themselves.

8 And Abenner son of Ner, Saul's commander, took Jebosthe son of Saul and brought him up from the camp to Manaem

9 and made him king over Galaaditis and Thasiri and Jezrael and Ephraim and Benjamin and all Israel.

10 Jebosthe son of Saul was forty years old when he reigned over Israel, and he reigned two years, except the house of Judah, who were after David;

11 and the days that David reigned in Chebron over the house of Judah were seven years and six months.

12 And Abenner son of Ner and the servants of Jebosthe son of Saul went out from Manaem to Gabaon;

13 and Joab son of Sarouia and David's servants went out from Chebron and meet them together by the spring of Gabaon, and these sat by the spring of Gabaon on this side and those by the spring on that side.

14 And Abenner said to Joab, Let the young men rise and play before us. And Joab said, Let them rise.

15 And they rose and passed over in number, twelve of the sons of Benjamin belonging to Jebosthe son of Saul and twelve of David's servants.

16 And each grasped his neighbor's head with his hand and his knife went into his neighbor's side, and they fall together; and the name of that place was called Portion of the Plotters, which is in Gabaon.

17 And the battle was exceedingly harsh on that day, and Abenner and the men of Israel stumbled before David's servants. –

18 And the three sons of Sarouia were there, Joab and Abessa and Asael, and Asael was swift with his feet like a gazelle in the field.

19 And Asael pursued after Abenner and did not turn aside in going to the right or to the left behind Abenner.

20 And Abenner looked behind him and said, Is it you, Asael? And he said, It is I.

21 And Abenner said to him, Turn aside to the right or to the left and seize for yourself one of the young men and take his armor for yourself; and Asael did not wish to turn aside from behind him.

22 And Abenner continued to say to Asael, Depart from me, lest I strike you to the ground; and how shall I lift my face toward Joab? And where are these things? Return to Joab your brother.

23 And he did not wish to depart. And Abenner strikes him with the back of the spear at the loin, and the spear passed out behind him, and he falls there and dies beneath him. And everyone who came as far as the place where Asael fell there and died stopped. –

24 And Joab and Abessa pursued after Abenner; and the sun was setting, and they came as far as the hill Amman, which faces Gai on the wilderness road of Gabaon.

25 And the sons of Benjamin who were after Abenner gather and became one meeting and stood atop one hill.

26 And Abenner called to Joab and said, Shall the sword devour to victory? Do you not know that it will be bitter in the end? And how long will you not tell the people to turn back from following our brothers?

27 And Joab said, As the Lord lives, if you had not spoken, for then from morning the people would have gone up, each after his brother.

28 And Joab sounded the trumpet, and all the people stopped and did not pursue after Israel and did not continue to fight.

29 And Abenner and his men departed westward all that night and crossed the Jordan and went all along the extended stretch and came to the camp.

30 And Joab returned from following Abenner and gathered all the people, and nineteen men of David's servants and Asael were missing.

31 And David's servants struck of the sons of Benjamin, of Abenner's men, three hundred and sixty men besides him.

32 And they took Asael and buried him in his father's tomb in Bethlehem. And Joab and the men with him went all night, and dawn broke for them in Chebron.

Chapter 3

1 And war continued for a long time between the house of Saul and the house of David; and the house of David went on and grew strong, and the house of Saul went on and grew weak.

2 And sons were born to David in Chebron, and his firstborn was Amnon by Achinoom the Jezraelite,

3 and his second Dalouia by Abigaia the Carmelite, and the third Abessalom son of Maacha daughter of Tholmi king of Gesir,

4 and the fourth Ornia son of Pheggith, and the fifth Sabatia by Abital,

5 and the sixth Jetheraam by Aigla David's wife; these were born to David in Chebron.

6 And it happened while the war was between the house of Saul and the house of David that Abenner was holding the house of Saul.

7 And Saul had a concubine, Respha daughter of Jal; and Memphibosthe son of Saul said to Abenner, Why did you go in to my father's concubine?

8 And Abenner was very angry at Memphibosthe's word, and Abenner said to him, Am I a dog's head? I have shown mercy today to the house of Saul your father and to brothers and acquaintances and have not deserted to the house of David; and you seek against me over a woman's wrongdoing today?

9 May God do thus to Abenner and add thus to him, for as the Lord swore to David, so I will do for him on this day,

10 to remove the kingdom from the house of Saul and raise up David's throne over Israel and over Judah from Dan to Bersabee.

11 And Memphibosthe could no longer answer Abenner a word for fear of him.

12 And Abenner sent messengers to David at Thailam, where he was at once, saying, Make your covenant with me, and behold, my hand is with you to turn all the house of Israel to you.

13 And David said, I will indeed make a covenant with you, except one thing I ask of you, saying, You shall not see my face unless you bring Melchol daughter of Saul when you come to see my face.

14 And David sent messengers to Memphibosthe son of Saul, saying, Give me back my wife Melchol, whom I took for a hundred foreskins of foreigners.

15 And Memphibosthe sent and took her from her husband, from Phaltiel son of Selles.

16 And her husband went with her, weeping behind her as far as Barakim; and Abenner said to him, Go, return; and he returned. –

17 And Abenner said to the elders of Israel, saying, Yesterday and the third day you sought David to reign over you;

18 and now do it, because the Lord spoke concerning David, saying, By the hand of my servant David I will save Israel from the hand of the foreigners and from the hand of all their enemies.

19 And Abenner spoke in the ears of Benjamin. And Abenner went to speak in David's ears in Chebron all that pleased Israel's eyes and the eyes of all the house of Benjamin.

20 And Abenner came to David in Chebron with twenty men. And David made a drinking feast for Abenner and the men with him.

21 And Abenner said to David, I will rise and go and gather all Israel to my lord the king and make a covenant with you, and you shall reign over all that your soul desires. And David sent Abenner away, and he went in peace. –

22 And behold, David's servants and Joab were arriving from the expedition and carried much spoil with them; and Abenner was not with David in Chebron, because he had sent him away and he had departed in peace.

23 And Joab and all his army were brought in, and it was reported to Joab, saying, Abenner son of Ner came to David, and he sent him away and he departed in peace.

24 And Joab came to the king and said, What is this you have done? Behold, Abenner came to you, and why did you send him away so that he departed in peace?

25 Do you not know the evil of Abenner son of Ner, that he came to deceive you and know your going out and your coming in and know all that you do?

26 And Joab returned from David and sent messengers after Abenner, and they bring him back from the well of Seiram; and David did not know.

27 And Abenner returned to Chebron, and Joab turned him aside at the side of the gate to speak to him in ambush and struck him there in the loin, and he died for the blood of Asael, Joab's brother.

28 And David heard after these things and said, I and my kingdom are innocent before the Lord forever of the blood of Abenner son of Ner;

29 may it come down upon Joab's head and all his father's house, and may there not fail from Joab's house one with a discharge and a leper and one holding a staff and one falling by the sword and one lacking bread.

30 And Joab and Abessa his brother had been watching Abenner closely because he put Asael their brother to death in Gabaon in the war. –

31 And David said to Joab and all the people with him, Tear your garments and gird yourselves with sackcloth and mourn before Abenner; and King David went behind the bier.

32 And they bury Abenner in Chebron; and the king raised his voice and wept at his tomb, and all the people wept over Abenner.

33 And the king lamented over Abenner and said, Shall Abenner die like the death of Nabal?

34 Your hands were not bound, your feet were not in fetters; he did not bring forward like Nabal; before sons of wrongdoing you fell. And all the people gathered to weep for him.

35 And all the people came to give David a meal of bread while it was still day, and David swore, saying, May God do thus to me and add thus, if before the sun sets I taste bread or anything at all.

36 And all the people knew, and everything the king did before the people was pleasing before them.

37 And all the people and all Israel knew on that day that it had not been from the king to put Abenner son of Ner to death.

38 And the king said to his servants, Do you not know that a great leader has fallen in Israel on this day?

39 And I am today a kinsman and appointed under a king, but these men, sons of Sarouia, are harder than I; may the Lord repay the one doing evil according to his evil.

Chapter 4

1 And Memphibosthe son of Saul heard that Abenner had died in Chebron, and his hands grew weak, and all the men of Israel became slack.

2 And two men, leaders of bands for Memphibosthe son of Saul, the name of one was Baana and the name of the second Rechab, sons of Remmon the Berothite, of the sons of Benjamin; for Beroth was reckoned to the sons of Benjamin,

3 and the Berothites fled to Getthaim and were sojourners there until this day. –

4 And Jonathan son of Saul had a son stricken in the feet; he was five years old when the report about Saul and Jonathan his son came from Jezrael, and his nurse took him and fled, and it happened as she hurried and withdrew that he fell and became lame, and his name was Memphibosthe. –

5 And the sons of Remmon the Berothite, Rekcha and Baana, went and entered in the heat of the day into the house of Memphibosthe, and he slept on the midday bed,

6 and behold, the doorkeeper of the house was cleaning wheat and grew drowsy and slept, and Rekcha and Baana the brothers slipped through

7 and entered the house, and Memphibosthe slept on his bed in his bedroom, and they strike him and put him to death and remove his head, and they took his head and departed on the westward road all night.

8 And they brought the head of Memphibosthe to David in Chebron and said to the king, Behold, the head of Memphibosthe son of Saul your enemy, who sought your life, and the Lord gave to my lord the king vengeance upon his enemies as on this day, upon Saul your enemy and his seed.

9 And David answered Rekcha and Baana his brother, sons of Remmon the Berothite, and said to them, As the Lord lives, who redeemed my life from every distress,

10 when the one telling me that Saul had died – and he was like one announcing good news before me – I seized him and killed him in Sekelak, to whom I should have given a reward for good news;

11 and now evil men have killed a righteous man in his house on his bed; and now I will seek his blood from your hands and destroy you from the earth.

12 And David commanded his young men, and they kill them and cut off their hands and their feet and hung them by the spring in Chebron; and the head of Memphibosthe they buried in the tomb of Abenner son of Ner.

Chapter 5

1 And all the tribes of Israel come to David in Chebron and said to him, Behold, we are your bones and your flesh;

2 and yesterday and the third day, when Saul was king over us, you were the one leading Israel out and bringing them in, and the Lord said to you, You shall shepherd my people Israel, and you shall be a leader over Israel.

3 And all the elders of Israel come to the king in Chebron, and King David made a covenant with them in Chebron before the Lord, and they anoint David king over all Israel. –

4 David was a son of thirty years when he began to reign, and he reigned forty years,

5 seven years and six months he reigned in Chebron over Judah, and thirty-three years he reigned over all Israel and Judah in Jerusalem.

6 And David and his men departed to Jerusalem against the Jebusite dwelling in the land. And it was said to David, You shall not enter here, because the blind and the lame stood against you, saying, David shall not enter here.

7 And David took the stronghold of Sion [this is the city of David].

8 And David said on that day, Everyone striking a Jebusite, let him touch with a dagger both the lame and the blind and those hating David's soul; therefore they will say, Blind and lame shall not enter the house of the Lord.

9 And David sat in the stronghold, and it was called the city of David; and he built the city around from the citadel and his house.

10 And David went on going and growing great, and the Lord Almighty was with him. –

11 And Chiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David and cedar wood and carpenters of wood and masons of stone, and they built a house for David.

12 And David knew that the Lord had established him as king over Israel and that his kingdom was raised up for the sake of his people Israel. –

13 And David took more wives and concubines from Jerusalem after he came from Chebron, and more sons and daughters were born to David.

14 And these are the names of those born to him in Jerusalem: Sammous and Sobab and Nathan and Salomon

15 and Ebear and Elisous and Naphek and Jephies

16 and Elisama and Elidae and Eliphalath,

16 and Elisama and Elidae and Eliphalath,

17 And the foreigners heard that David had been anointed king over Israel, and all the foreigners went up to seek David; and David heard and went down to the stronghold.

18 And the foreigners come and fell together in the valley of the Titans.

19 And David asked through the Lord, saying, Shall I go up against the foreigners, and will you give them into my hands? And the Lord said to David, Go up, because I will surely give the foreigners into your hands.

20 And David came from the Upper Breaches and cut down the foreigners there, and David said, The Lord has broken through my enemies the foreigners before me as waters are broken through; therefore the name of that place was called Upper Breaches.

21 And they leave their gods there, and David and the men with him took them. –

22 And the foreigners continued again to go up and fell together in the valley of the Titans.

23 And David inquired through the Lord, and the Lord said, You shall not go up to meet them; turn away from them and come upon them near the Weeping Place;

24 and it shall be when you hear the sound of the closing together of the grove of the Weeping Place, then you shall go down against them, because then the Lord will go out before you to strike in the battle against the foreigners.

25 And David did as the Lord commanded him and struck the foreigners from Gabaon to the land of Gazera.

Chapter 6

1 And David again gathered every young man from Israel, about seventy thousand.

2 And David and all the people with him rose and went from the rulers of Judah on an ascent to bring up from there the ark of God, upon which the name of the Lord of hosts, seated upon the cherubim, was invoked.

3 And he put the ark of the Lord upon a new wagon and took it from Aminadab's house on the hill; and Oza and his brothers, sons of Aminadab, drove the wagon

4 with the ark, and his brothers went before the ark.

5 And David and the sons of Israel played before the Lord with tuned instruments with strength and with songs and with lyres and harps and drums and cymbals and flutes.

6 And they come as far as the threshing floor of Nodab, and Oza stretched out his hand upon the ark of God to hold it and grasped it, because the calf had pulled it aside, to hold it.

7 And the Lord was angered with Oza, and God struck him there, and he died there beside the ark of the Lord before God.

8 And David was disheartened because the Lord had made a breach in Oza; and that place was called Breach of Oza until this day.

9 And David feared the Lord on that day, saying, How shall the ark of the Lord come in to me?

10 And David did not wish to turn aside the ark of the Lord's covenant to himself into the city of David, and David turned it aside to the house of Abeddara the Gethite.

11 And the ark of the Lord sat in the house of Abeddara the Gethite for three months; and the Lord blessed all the house of Abeddara and all that belonged to him.

12 And it was reported to King David, saying, The Lord has blessed Abeddara's house and all that belongs to him because of the ark of God. And David went and brought up the ark of the Lord from Abeddara's house to the city of David with joy.

13 And with those carrying the ark were seven dances and a sacrifice, a calf and lambs.

14 And David played with tuned instruments before the Lord, and David wore a striking garment.

15 And David and all the house of Israel brought up the ark of the Lord with shouting and with the sound of a trumpet.

16 And it happened as the ark came as far as the city of David that Melchol daughter of Saul looked through the window and saw King David dancing and playing before the Lord and despised him in her heart.

17 And they carry the ark of the Lord and set it in its place in the middle of the tent that David had pitched for it; and David offered up whole burnt offerings before the Lord and peace offerings.

18 And David finished offering together the whole burnt offerings and peace offerings and blessed the people in the name of the Lord of hosts.

19 And he distributed to all the people, to all the force of Israel from Dan to Bersabee, from man to woman, to each a round loaf of bread and a hearth cake and a cake from a pan; and all the people departed, each to his house. –

20 And David returned to bless his house, and Melchol daughter of Saul went out to meet David and blessed him and said, How glorified today was the king of Israel, who uncovered himself today in the eyes of the maidservants of his servants, as one of the dancers uncovers himself uncovered.

21 And David said to Melchol, Before the Lord I will dance; blessed be the Lord, who chose me above your father and above all his house to appoint me leader over his people, over Israel; and I will play and dance before the Lord

22 and will uncover myself still thus and be worthless in your eyes and with the maidservants among whom you said I was glorified.

23 And Melchol daughter of Saul had no child until the day of her death.

Chapter 7

1 And it happened when the king sat in his house and the Lord had allotted him rest all around from all his enemies around,

2 that the king said to Nathan the prophet, Behold now, I dwell in a cedar house, and the ark of God sits in the midst of the tent.

3 And Nathan said to the king, All that is in your heart, go and do, because the Lord is with you. –

4 And it happened on that night that the word of the Lord came to Nathan, saying,

5 Go and say to my servant David, Thus says the Lord: You shall not build me a house for me to dwell in;

6 for I have not dwelt in a house from the day I brought the sons of Israel up from Egypt until this day, and I was walking about in a lodging place and in a tent.

7 In all the places through which I passed in all Israel, did I ever speak to one tribe of Israel, whom I commanded to shepherd my people Israel, saying, Why have you not built me a cedar house?

8 And now thus you shall say to my servant David: Thus says the Lord Almighty: I took you from the sheepfold to be a leader over my people, over Israel,

9 and I was with you in all the places where you went, and I destroyed all your enemies from before you and made you renowned like the name of the great ones on earth.

10 And I will set a place for my people Israel and plant them, and they shall dwell by themselves and no longer be anxious, and a son of wrongdoing shall not continue to humble them as from the beginning,

11 from the days when I appointed judges over my people Israel, and I will give you rest from all your enemies, and the Lord will tell you that you will build him a house.

12 And it shall be when your days are fulfilled and you sleep with your fathers that I will raise up your seed after you, who shall be from your belly, and I will establish his kingdom;

13 he shall build me a house for my name, and I will set his throne upright forever.

14 I will be a father to him, and he shall be a son to me; and if his wrongdoing comes, I will reprove him with a rod of men and with the touches of sons of men;

15 but my mercy I will not remove from him as I removed it from those whom I removed from before me.

16 And his house and his kingdom shall be made faithful forever before me, and his throne shall be set upright forever.

17 According to all these words and all this vision, so Nathan spoke to David. –

18 And King David entered and sat before the Lord and said, Who am I, my lord Lord, and what is my house, that you have loved me to this extent?

19 And it was made a little thing before you, my lord Lord, and you spoke concerning your servant's house for a distant time; and this is the law of man, my lord Lord.

20 And what more shall David add to speak to you? And now you know your servant, my lord Lord.

21 For the sake of your word you have done it, and according to your heart you have done all this greatness to make it known to your servant,

22 for the sake of magnifying you, my lord Lord, because there is none like you and no God besides you among all that we have heard with our ears.

23 And who is like your people Israel, another nation on the earth? As God led them to redeem a people for himself, to make you a name, to do greatness and manifestation, to cast out for you from before your people whom you redeemed for yourself from Egypt, nations and dwellings.

24 And you established for yourself your people Israel as a people forever, and you, Lord, became God to them.

25 And now, my lord Lord, the word that you spoke concerning your servant and his house, make faithful forever, Lord Almighty, God of Israel; and now as you spoke,

26 may your name be magnified forever.

27 Lord Almighty, God of Israel, you uncovered your servant's ear, saying, I will build you a house; therefore your servant found his own heart to pray this prayer to you.

28 And now, my lord Lord, you are God, and your words shall be true, and you spoke these good things concerning your servant;

29 and now begin and bless the house of your servant to be before you forever, because you are, my lord Lord, you spoke, and from your blessing your servant's house shall be blessed forever.

Chapter 8

1 And it happened after these things that David struck the foreigners and routed them; and David took the separated place from the hand of the foreigners.

2 And David struck Moab and measured them with ropes after laying them on the ground, and there were two rope measures for putting to death, and two rope measures he kept alive, and Moab became servants to David bringing gifts.

3 And David struck Adraazar son of Raab king of Souba as he went to establish his hand over the river Euphrates.

4 And David took in advance from him a thousand chariots and seven thousand horsemen and twenty thousand foot soldiers, and David disabled all the chariots and left of them a hundred chariots.

5 And Syria of Damascus comes to help Adraazar king of Souba, and David struck twenty-two thousand men among the Syrians.

6 And David set a garrison in Syria by Damascus, and the Syrian became David's servants bringing gifts. And the Lord saved David in all the places where he went. –

7 And David took the golden bracelets that were on the servants of Adraazar king of Souba and brought them to Jerusalem; and Sousakim king of Egypt took them when he came up to Jerusalem in the days of Roboam son of Solomon.

8 And from Masbak, from Adraazar's chosen cities, King David took very much bronze; with it Salomon made the bronze sea and the pillars and the basins and all the equipment. –

9 And Thoou king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the force of Adraazar,

10 and Thoou sent Jeddouran his son to King David to ask him about peace and bless him because he fought Adraazar and struck him, because he was opposed to Adraazar, and in his hands were silver vessels and gold vessels and bronze vessels.

11 And King David consecrated these to the Lord along with the silver and the gold that he had consecrated from all the cities he had subdued,

12 from Idumea and the land of Moab and the sons of Ammon and the foreigners and Amalek and the spoils of Adraazar son of Raab king of Souba. –

13 And David made a name; and when he returned he struck Idumea in Gaimele, eighteen thousand.

14 And he set a garrison in Idumea, in all Idumea, and all the Idumeans became servants to the king. And the Lord saved David in all the places where he went.

15 And David reigned over Israel, and David was doing judgment and righteousness for all his people.

16 And Joab son of Sarouia was over the army, and Josaphat son of Achia over the records,

17 and Saddouk son of Achitob and Achimelech son of Abiathar were priests, and Asa was the scribe,

18 and Banaias son of Jodae was counselor, and the Cheletthite and the Pheletthite; and David's sons were court leaders.

Chapter 9

1 And David said, Is anyone still left of Saul's house, that I may show mercy to him for Jonathan's sake?

2 And there was a servant from Saul's house, and his name was Siba, and they call him to David. And the king said to him, Are you Siba? And he said, I am your servant.

3 And the king said, Is a man still left of Saul's house, that I may show him God's mercy? And Siba said to the king, There is still a son of Jonathan, stricken in the feet.

4 And the king said, Where is he? And Siba said to the king, Behold, in the house of Machir son of Amiel, from Ladabar.

5 And King David sent and took him from the house of Machir son of Amiel, from Ladabar.

6 And Memphibosthe son of Jonathan son of Saul comes to King David and fell on his face and bowed to him. And David said to him, Memphibosthe; and he said, Behold, your servant.

7 And David said to him, Do not fear, because I will surely show mercy to you for Jonathan your father's sake and will restore to you every field of Saul, the father of your father, and you shall eat bread at my table always.

8 And Memphibosthe bowed and said, Who am I, your servant, that you looked upon a dead dog like me?

9 And the king called Siba, Saul's servant, and said to him, All that belonged to Saul and all his house I have given to your lord's son;

10 and you shall work the land for him, you and your sons and your servants, and bring bread to your lord's son, and he shall eat it; and Memphibosthe, your lord's son, shall always eat bread at my table. [And Siba had fifteen sons and twenty servants.]

11 And Siba said to the king, According to all that my lord the king has commanded his servant, so your servant will do. And Memphibosthe ate at David's table like one of the king's sons.

12 And Memphibosthe had a little son, and his name was Micha. And all the household of Siba's house were servants of Memphibosthe.

13 And Memphibosthe dwelt in Jerusalem, because he always ate at the king's table; and he was lame in both his feet.

Chapter 10

1 And it happened after these things that the king of the sons of Ammon died, and Annon his son reigned in his place.

2 And David said, I will show mercy to Annon son of Naas, in the way his father showed mercy to me; and David sent to comfort him by the hand of his servants concerning his father. And David's servants came to the land of the sons of Ammon.

3 And the rulers of the sons of Ammon said to Annon their lord, Is it out of honoring your father before you that David sent comforters to you? Did David not send his servants to you so that they might search the city and spy it out and examine it?

4 And Annon took David's servants and shaved their beards and cut their mantles in half as far as their hips and sent them away.

5 And they reported to David about the men, and he sent to meet them, because the men had been greatly dishonored; and the king said, Sit in Jericho until your beards grow, and you shall return. –

6 And the sons of Ammon saw that they had been shamed by David's people, and the sons of Ammon sent and hired Syria of Baithroob, twenty thousand foot soldiers, and the king of Maacha, a thousand men, and Istob, twelve thousand men.

7 And David heard and sent Joab and all the force, the mighty men.

8 And the sons of Ammon went out and drew up for battle by the door of the gate, and Syria of Souba and Roob and Istob and Maacha were alone in the field.

9 And Joab saw that the face of battle was against him, from the front opposite him and from behind, and chose from all the young men of Israel, and they drew up opposite Syria.

10 And the remainder of the people he placed in the hand of Abessa his brother, and they drew up opposite the sons of Ammon.

11 And he said, If Syria grows strong against me, you shall be for my salvation, and if the sons of Ammon grow strong against you, we shall save you;

12 be a man, and let us grow strong for our people and for the cities of our God, and the Lord will do what is good in his eyes.

13 And Joab and his people with him came forward for battle against Syria, and they fled before him.

14 And the sons of Ammon saw that Syria had fled, and they fled before Abessa and entered the city. And Joab returned from the sons of Ammon, and they came to Jerusalem. –

15 And Syria saw that it had stumbled before Israel, and they gathered together.

16 And Adraazar sent and gathered the Syrians from beyond the river Chalamak, and they came to Ailam, and Sobak, commander of Adraazar's force, was before them.

17 And it was reported to David, and he gathered all Israel and crossed the Jordan and came to Ailam; and Syria drew up opposite David and fought with him.

18 And Syria fled before Israel, and David slew from Syria seven hundred chariots and forty thousand horsemen; and he struck Sobak the commander of his force, and he died there.

19 And all the kings who were servants of Adraazar saw that they had stumbled before Israel, and they deserted to Israel and served them. And Syria feared to save the sons of Ammon any longer.

Chapter 11

1 And it happened when the year turned at the time of the going out of kings that David sent Joab and his servants with him and all Israel, and they destroyed the sons of Ammon and sat besieging Rabbath; and David sat in Jerusalem.

2 And it happened toward evening that David rose from his bed and walked on the roof of the king's house and saw a woman bathing from the roof, and the woman was very beautiful in appearance.

3 And David sent and sought out the woman, and he said, Is this not Bersabee daughter of Eliab, wife of Ourias the Chettite?

4 And David sent messengers and took her, and she came to him, and he slept with her, and she was being sanctified from her uncleanness, and she returned to her house.

5 And the woman conceived; and she sent and told David and said, I am with child.

6 And David sent to Joab, saying, Send me Ourias the Chettite; and Joab sent Ourias to David.

7 And Ourias comes and entered to him, and David asked about the peace of Joab and the peace of the people and the peace of the war.

8 And David said to Ourias, Go down to your house and wash your feet; and Ourias went out from the king's house, and a gift from the king went out after him.

9 And Ourias slept by the king's door with his lord's servants and did not go down to his house.

10 And they told David, saying that Ourias did not go down to his house. And David said to Ourias, Have you not come from a journey? Why did you not go down to your house?

11 And Ourias said to David, The ark and Israel and Judah dwell in tents, and my lord Joab and my lord's servants are encamped upon the face of the field; and shall I enter my house to eat and drink and sleep with my wife? How? As your soul lives, I shall not do this thing.

12 And David said to Ourias, Sit here today too, and tomorrow I will send you away; and Ourias sat in Jerusalem that day and the next.

13 And David called him, and he ate before him and drank, and he made him drunk; and he went out in the evening to sleep on his bed with his lord's servants, and did not go down to his house.

14 And it happened in the morning that David wrote a letter to Joab and sent it in Ourias's hand.

15 And he wrote in the letter, saying, Bring Ourias opposite the strong battle, and turn back from behind him, and he shall be struck and die.

16 And it happened as Joab watched the city that he placed Ourias in the place where he knew that mighty men were.

17 And the men of the city went out and fought with Joab, and some of the people of David's servants fell, and Ourias the Chettite died too.

18 And Joab sent and reported to the king all the words of the war

19 and commanded the messenger, saying, When you finish speaking all the words of the war to the king,

20 it shall be, if the king's anger rises and he says to you, Why did you approach the city to fight? Did you not know that they would shoot from above the wall?

21 Who struck Abimelech son of Jerobaal? Did a woman not throw a piece of millstone on him from above the wall, and he died in Thamasi? Why did you approach the wall? Then say, Your servant Ourias the Chettite also died.

22 And Joab's messenger went to the king in Jerusalem and came and reported to David all that Joab had reported to him, all the words of the war. And David was angered with Joab and said to the messenger, Why did you approach the city to fight? Did you not know that you would be struck from the wall? Who struck Abimelech son of Jerobaal? Did a woman not throw a piece of millstone on him from the wall, and he died in Thamasi? Why did you approach the wall?

23 And the messenger said to David, Because the men grew strong against us and came out against us into the field, and we came upon them as far as the door of the gate,

24 and the archers shot at your servants from above the wall, and some of the king's servants died, and your servant Ourias the Chettite died too.

25 And David said to the messenger, Thus you shall say to Joab: Let this thing not be evil in your eyes, because sometimes thus and sometimes thus the sword devours; strengthen your battle against the city and pull it down and strengthen him.

26 And Ourias's wife heard that Ourias her husband had died, and she mourned her husband.

27 And the mourning passed, and David sent and gathered her to his house, and she became his wife and bore him a son. And the thing that David had done appeared evil in the eyes of the Lord.

Chapter 12

1 And the Lord sent Nathan the prophet to David, and he entered to him and said to him, There were two men in one city, one rich and one poor;

2 and the rich man had very many flocks and herds,

3 but the poor man had nothing except one little ewe lamb, which he acquired and kept and raised, and it grew with him and with his sons together, ate from his bread and drank from his cup and slept in his bosom and was like a daughter to him;

4 and a traveler came to the rich man, and he spared taking from his flocks and his herds to prepare for the traveling stranger who had come to him, and he took the poor man's ewe lamb and prepared it for the man who had come to him.

5 And David was very angry with the man, and David said to Nathan, As the Lord lives, the man who did this is a son of death,

6 and he shall repay the ewe lamb sevenfold because he did this thing and because he did not spare.

7 And Nathan said to David, You are the man who did this; thus says the Lord God of Israel: I anointed you king over Israel, and I delivered you from Saul's hand

8 and gave you your lord's house and your lord's wives into your bosom and gave you the house of Israel and Judah; and if it is little, I will add to you according to these things.

9 Why did you slight the word of the Lord to do evil in his eyes? You struck Ourias the Chettite with the sword and took his wife as a wife for yourself, and you killed him by the sword of the sons of Ammon.

10 And now the sword shall not depart from your house forever because you despised me and took the wife of Ourias the Chettite to be your wife.

11 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am raising up evils against you from your house, and I will take your wives before your eyes and give them to your neighbor, and he shall sleep with your wives before this sun;

12 because you did it secretly, but I will do this thing before all Israel and before this sun.

13 And David said to Nathan, I have sinned against the Lord. And Nathan said to David, And the Lord has passed over your sin; you shall certainly not die;

14 except that by this thing you have surely provoked the Lord's enemies, and your son born to you shall surely die.

15 And Nathan departed to his house. And the Lord struck the child whom Ourias's wife bore to David, and it became sick.

16 And David sought God for the young child, and David fasted a fast and went in and spent the night in sackcloth on the ground.

17 And the elders of his house rose over him to raise him from the ground, and he would not and did not eat bread with them.

18 And it happened on the seventh day that the young child died; and David's servants feared to tell him that the young child had died, because they said, Behold, while the young child still lived we spoke to him and he did not listen to our voice; and how shall we say to him that the young child has died? And he will do evil.

19 And David understood that his servants were whispering, and David perceived that the young child had died; and David said to his servants, Has the young child died? And they said, He has died.

20 And David rose from the ground and washed and anointed himself and changed his garments and entered the house of God and worshiped him; and he entered his house and asked for bread to eat, and they set bread before him, and he ate.

21 And his servants said to him, What is this thing you have done? For the sake of the young child while he was still living you fasted and wept and kept vigil, and when the young child died, you rose and ate bread and drank.

22 And David said, While the young child still lived I fasted and wept, because I said, Who knows if the Lord will have mercy on me and the young child will live?

23 And now he has died; why should I fast? Can I bring him back again? I shall go to him, and he shall not return to me.

24 And David comforted Bersabee his wife and went in to her and slept with her, and she conceived and bore a son, and he called his name Salomon, and the Lord loved him.

25 And he sent by the hand of Nathan the prophet, and he called his name Jededi for the Lord's sake.

26 And Joab fought in Rabbath of the sons of Ammon and took the royal city.

27 And Joab sent messengers to David and said, I fought in Rabbath and took the city of the waters;

28 and now gather the remainder of the people and encamp against the city and take it first, lest I take the city first and my name be called upon it.

29 And David gathered all the people and went to Rabbath and fought in it and took it.

30 And he took the crown of Melchol their king from his head, and its weight was a talent of gold and a precious stone, and it was upon David's head; and he brought out very much spoil from the city.

31 And he brought out the people in it and placed them in the saw and the iron threshing tools and led them through the brickworks; and thus he did to all the cities of the sons of Ammon. And David and all the people returned to Jerusalem.

Chapter 13

1 And it happened after these things that Abessalom son of David had a sister very beautiful in appearance, and her name was Themar, and Amnon son of David loved her.

2 And Amnon was distressed to the point of becoming ill because of Themar his sister, because she was a virgin, and it was excessive in Amnon's eyes to do anything to her.

3 And Amnon had a companion, and his name was Jonadab son of Samaa, David's brother; and Jonadab was a very clever man.

4 And he said to him, Why are you thus weak, king's son, morning by morning? Will you not tell me? And Amnon said to him, I love Themar, the sister of my brother Abessalom.

5 And Jonadab said to him, Lie on your bed and act ill, and your father will enter to see you, and you shall say to him, Let Themar my sister come and feed me and prepare food before my eyes, so that I may see and eat from her hands.

6 And Amnon lay down and became ill, and the king entered to see him, and Amnon said to the king, Let Themar my sister come to me and make two small loaves before my eyes, and I will eat from her hand.

7 And David sent to Themar in the house, saying, Go now to the house of Amnon your brother and prepare food for him.

8 And Themar went to the house of Amnon her brother, and he was lying down. And she took the dough and kneaded it and made small loaves before his eyes and baked the loaves;

9 and she took the pan and emptied it before him, and he did not wish to eat. And Amnon said, Bring every man out from me; and they brought every man out from him.

10 And Amnon said to Themar, Bring the food into the chamber, and I will eat from your hand. And Themar took the small loaves she had made and brought them to Amnon her brother into the bedroom

11 and brought them to him to eat, and he seized her and said to her, Come, sleep with me, my sister.

12 And she said to him, No, my brother, do not humble me, because this is not done in Israel; do not do this folly;

13 and where shall I carry my reproach? And you shall be like one of the fools in Israel; and now speak to the king, because he will certainly not withhold me from you.

14 And Amnon did not wish to listen to her voice and grew stronger than she and humbled her and slept with her.

15 And Amnon hated her with a very great hatred, because the hatred with which he hated her was greater than the love with which he had loved her. And Amnon said to her, Rise and go.

16 And Themar said to him, No, brother, because this last evil is greater than the first that you did with me, to send me away. And Amnon did not wish to listen to her voice.

17 And he called his young man who stood over his house and said to him, Send this woman out from me now and shut the door behind her.

18 And she wore a many-colored tunic, because thus the king's daughters who were virgins wore their outer garments; and his attendant brought her out and shut the door behind her;

19 and Themar took ashes and put them on her head and tore the many-colored tunic she wore and put her hands upon her head and went on walking and crying out.

20 And Abessalom her brother said to her, Has Amnon your brother been with you? And now, my sister, be silent, for he is your brother; do not set your heart to speak about this thing. And Themar sat desolate in the house of Abessalom her brother.

21 And King David heard all these words and was very angry; and he did not grieve the spirit of Amnon his son, because he loved him, because he was his firstborn.

22 And Abessalom did not speak with Amnon from evil to good, because Abessalom hated Amnon on account of the matter that he had humbled Themar his sister.

23 And it happened after two years of days that they were shearing for Abessalom in Belasor adjoining Ephraim, and Abessalom called all the king's sons.

24 And Abessalom came to the king and said, Behold now, they are shearing for your servant; let the king and his servants go with your servant.

25 And the king said to Abessalom, No, my son, let not all of us go, lest we burden you. And he pressed him, but he did not wish to go and blessed him.

26 And Abessalom said, But if not, let Amnon my brother go with us. And the king said to him, Why should he go with you?

27 And Abessalom pressed him, and he sent Amnon and all the king's sons with him. And Abessalom made a drinking feast like the king's feast.

28 And Abessalom commanded his young men, saying, Watch when Amnon's heart becomes glad with wine and I say to you, Strike Amnon, and put him to death; do not fear, for is it not I who command you? Be men and become sons of strength.

29 And Abessalom's young men did to Amnon as Abessalom commanded them. And all the king's sons rose and each mounted his mule and fled.

30 And it happened while they were on the road that the report came to David, saying, Abessalom has struck all the king's sons, and not even one of them has been left.

31 And the king rose and tore his garments and lay upon the ground, and all his servants standing around him tore their garments.

32 And Jonadab son of Samaa, David's brother, answered and said, Let not my lord the king say that he put to death all the young men, the king's sons, because Amnon alone has died; for it had lain on Abessalom's mouth since the day he humbled Themar his sister;

33 and now let not my lord the king place a word on his heart saying, All the king's sons have died, because only Amnon alone has died.

34 And Abessalom escaped. And the young watchman raised his eyes and saw, and behold, many people going on the road behind him from the side of the mountain on the descent; and the watchman came and reported to the king and said, I have seen men from the road of Oronen from the side of the mountain.

35 And Jonadab said to the king, Behold, the king's sons are present; according to your servant's word, so it happened.

36 And it happened when he finished speaking that behold, the king's sons came and raised their voices and wept, and the king and all his servants also wept with a very great weeping.

37 And Abessalom fled and went to Tholmai son of Emioud king of Gedsour in the land of Machad. And King David mourned his son all the days.

38 And Abessalom escaped and went to Gedsour and was there three years.

39 And the king's spirit ceased from going out after Abessalom, because he was comforted over Amnon, because he had died.

Chapter 14

1 And Joab son of Sarouia knew that the king's heart was upon Abessalom.

2 And Joab sent to Thekoe and took a wise woman from there and said to her, Mourn now and put on mourning garments and do not anoint yourself with oil, and be like a woman mourning one who has died for many days,

3 and you shall go to the king and speak to him according to this word; and Joab placed the words in her mouth.

4 And the Thekoite woman entered to the king and fell on her face to the ground and bowed to him and said, Save, king, save.

5 And the king said to her, What is it with you? And she said, I am indeed a widow, and my husband died.

6 And your servant had two sons, and they both fought in the field, and there was no one to deliver between them, and the one struck his brother and put him to death.

7 And behold, the whole family rose against your servant and said, Give the one who struck his brother, and we will put him to death in exchange for his brother's life whom he killed, and we will remove your heir too; and they will extinguish my remaining coal so as not to leave my husband a remnant and a name on the face of the earth.

8 And the king said, Go in health to your house, and I will command concerning you.

9 And the Thekoite woman said to the king, Upon me, my lord king, be the lawlessness and upon my father's house, and the king and his throne are innocent.

10 And the king said, Who is the one speaking to you? Bring him to me, and he will no longer continue to touch him.

11 And she said, Let the king remember the Lord his God, lest a kinsman of blood multiply to destroy, and they shall certainly not remove my son. And he said, As the Lord lives, not a hair of your son shall fall to the ground.

12 And the woman said, Let your servant speak a word to my lord the king. And he said, Speak.

13 And the woman said, Why did you reckon such a thing against God's people? Is this word from the king's mouth like an offense, in that the king does not bring back his own banished one?

14 For we shall surely die, and like water poured upon the earth that shall not be gathered; and God will take a life, and he reckons concerning driving away a banished one from himself.

15 And now I have come to speak this word to my lord the king because the people will see me, and your servant will say, Let me now speak to the king, if perhaps the king will do the word of his servant;

16 for the king will listen to deliver his servant from the hand of the man seeking to remove me and my son from God's inheritance.

17 And the woman said, May the word of my lord the king be a sacrifice, because like an angel of God, so is my lord the king in hearing the good and the evil, and the Lord your God shall be with you.

18 And the king answered and said to the woman, Do not hide from me the thing I ask you. And the woman said, Let my lord the king speak.

19 And the king said, Is Joab's hand with you in all this? And the woman said to the king, As your soul lives, my lord king, there is nothing to the right or to the left of all that my lord the king has spoken, because your servant Joab himself commanded me and himself placed all these words in your servant's mouth;

20 for the sake of going around the face of this matter your servant Joab did this thing, and my lord is wise like the wisdom of an angel of God to know all that is in the land.

21 And the king said to Joab, Behold, I have done for you according to this word of yours; go, bring back the young man Abessalom.

22 And Joab fell on his face to the ground and bowed and blessed the king, and Joab said, Today your servant knows that I have found favor in your eyes, my lord king, because my lord the king has done the word of his servant.

23 And Joab rose and went to Gedsour and brought Abessalom to Jerusalem.

24 And the king said, Let him return to his house and not see my face. And Abessalom returned to his house and did not see the king's face. –

25 And there was no man in all Israel so greatly praised as Abessalom; from the sole of his foot to the top of his head there was no blemish in him.

26 And when he sheared his head – and it happened from the beginning of days to days whenever he was sheared, because it weighed heavily upon him – when he sheared it, he weighed the hair of his head, two hundred shekels by the royal shekel.

27 And three sons and one daughter were born to Abessalom, and her name was Themar; she was a very beautiful woman and became the wife of Roboam son of Salomon and bore him Abia.

28 And Abessalom sat in Jerusalem two years of days and did not see the king's face.

29 And Abessalom sent to Joab to send him to the king, and he did not wish to come to him; and he sent to him a second time, and he did not wish to come.

30 And Abessalom said to his servants, See Joab's portion in the field adjoining mine, and he has barley there; go and set it on fire; and Abessalom's servants set it on fire. And Joab's servants come to him with their garments torn and said, Abessalom's servants burned the portion with fire.

31 And Joab rose and came to Abessalom in the house and said to him, Why did your servants burn my portion with fire?

32 And Abessalom said to Joab, Behold, I sent to you, saying, Come here and I will send you to the king, saying, Why did I come from Gedsour? It was good for me to remain there; and now behold, I have not seen the king's face; and if there is wrongdoing in me, put me to death.

33 And Joab entered to the king and told him, and he called Abessalom, and he entered to the king and bowed to him and fell on his face to the ground before the king, and the king kissed Abessalom.

Chapter 15

1 And it happened after these things that Abessalom made for himself chariots and horses and fifty men to run before him.

2 And Abessalom rose early and stood beside the way of the gate, and it happened that every man who had a case came to the king for judgment, and Abessalom would call to him and say to him, From what city are you? And the man said, Your servant is from one of the tribes of Israel.

3 And Abessalom said to him, Behold, your words are good and easy, but there is no one from the king to hear you;

4 and Abessalom said, Who will appoint me judge in the land, so that every man who has a dispute and judgment may come to me, and I will vindicate him?

5 And it happened when a man drew near to bow to him that he stretched out his hand and took hold of him and kissed him.

6 And Abessalom did according to this thing to all Israel who came to the king for judgment, and Abessalom made the hearts of Israel's men his own.

7 And it happened at the end of forty years that Abessalom said to his father, Let me go now and pay my vows which I vowed to the Lord in Chebron;

8 for your servant vowed a vow while I dwelt in Gedsour in Syria, saying, If the Lord surely returns me to Jerusalem, then I will serve the Lord.

9 And the king said to him, Go in peace; and he rose and went to Chebron.

10 And Abessalom sent scouts among all the tribes of Israel, saying, When you hear the sound of the horn, you shall say, Abessalom has become king in Chebron.

11 And with Abessalom went two hundred invited men from Jerusalem, going in their simplicity, and they knew nothing of the matter.

12 And Abessalom sent and called Achitophel the Gelmonite, David's counselor, from his city, from Gola, while he was sacrificing. And the band became strong, and the people going with Abessalom were many.

13 And one reporting came to David, saying, The heart of Israel's men has gone after Abessalom.

14 And David said to all his servants with him in Jerusalem, Rise and let us flee, because there is no salvation for us from before Abessalom; hurry to go, lest he hurry and overtake us and thrust evil upon us and strike the city with the edge of the sword.

15 And the king's servants said to the king, According to all that our lord the king chooses, behold, your servants.

16 And the king and all his household went out on their feet; and the king left ten women of his concubines to guard the house.

17 And the king and all his servants went out on foot and stood at the distant house.

18 And all his servants passed by his side, and all the Chetti and all the Pheletthe stood by the olive tree in the wilderness; and all the people passed along beside him and all those around him and all the mature men and all the warriors, six hundred men, and stood beside him; and all the Cheretthite and all the Pheletthite and all the Gethites, six hundred men who had come on foot from Geth, went before the king.

19 And the king said to Etthi the Gethite, Why do you too go with us? Return and dwell with the king, because you are a foreigner and have migrated from your place.

20 If you arrived yesterday, shall I move you with us today and will you move from your place? Yesterday was your departure, and today shall I move you with us to go? And I will go wherever I go. Return and take your brothers back with you, and the Lord will show you mercy and truth.

21 And Etthi answered the king and said, As the Lord lives and as my lord the king lives, wherever my lord is, whether for death or for life, there your servant shall be.

22 And the king said to Etthi, Come and cross with me; and Etthi the Gethite passed along and all his servants and all the crowd with him.

23 And all the land wept with a great voice. And all the people were passing through the torrent bed Kedron, and the king crossed the torrent bed Kedron; and all the people and the king passed on toward the wilderness road. –

24 And behold, Saddok too and all the Levites with him carried the ark of the Lord's covenant from Baithar and set down the ark of God, and Abiathar went up, until all the people had finished passing out of the city.

25 And the king said to Saddok, Return the ark of God to the city; if I find favor in the Lord's eyes, he will bring me back and show me it and its beauty;

26 and if he says thus, I have not desired you, behold, here I am, let him do to me what is good in his eyes.

27 And the king said to Saddok the priest, See, you return to the city in peace, and Achimaas your son and Jonathan son of Abiathar, your two sons, with you;

28 see, I will be encamped in the plains of the wilderness until a word comes from you to tell me.

29 And Saddok and Abiathar returned the ark to Jerusalem and sat there.

30 And David went up the ascent of the olives, going up and weeping, his head covered, and he went barefoot, and all the people with him, each man covered his head, and they went up, going up and weeping. –

31 And it was reported to David, saying, Achitophel too is among those conspiring with Abessalom; and David said, Scatter now Achitophel's counsel, Lord my God.

32 And David was coming as far as Roos, where he worshiped God, and behold, Chousi the Archite, David's companion, came to meet him with his tunic torn and earth on his head.

33 And David said to him, If you cross with me, you will be a burden to me;

34 but if you return to the city, you shall say to Abessalom, Your brothers have passed through, and the king, your father, passed through behind me, and now I am your servant, king, let me live; I was your father's servant then and just now, and now I am your servant; and you will scatter Achitophel's counsel for me.

35 And behold, Saddok and Abiathar the priests are there with you, and every word that you hear from the king's house you shall report to Saddok and Abiathar the priests;

36 behold, there with them are their two sons, Achimaas son of Saddok and Jonathan son of Abiathar, and by their hand you shall send me every word that you hear.

37 And Chousi, David's companion, entered the city, and Abessalom was entering Jerusalem. –

Chapter 16

1 And David passed a little way from Roos, and behold, Siba, Memphibosthe's servant, met him with a pair of saddled donkeys, and on them two hundred loaves and a hundred clusters of raisins and a hundred dates and a skin of wine.

2 And the king said to Siba, What are these for you? And Siba said, The beasts of burden are for the king's household to ride, and the loaves and dates for the young men to eat, and the wine for those who are faint in the wilderness to drink.

3 And the king said, And where is your lord's son? And Siba said to the king, Behold, he sits in Jerusalem, because he said, Today the house of Israel will restore to me my father's kingdom.

4 And the king said to Siba, Behold, all that belongs to Memphibosthe is yours. And Siba bowed and said, May I find favor in your eyes, my lord king. –

5 And King David came as far as Baourim; and behold, a man came out from there, from the kinship of Saul's house, and his name was Semei son of Gera; he came out going and cursing

6 and stoning David and all the servants of King David with stones, and all the people and all the mighty men were on the king's right and left.

7 And thus Semei said as he cursed him, Go out, go out, man of blood and lawless man;

8 the Lord has returned upon you all the blood of Saul's house, because you reigned in his place, and the Lord has given the kingdom into the hand of Abessalom your son; and behold, you are in your evil, because you are a man of blood.

9 And Abessa son of Sarouia said to the king, Why does this dead dog curse my lord the king? Let me cross over now and take off his head.

10 And the king said, What is it to me and to you, sons of Sarouia? Leave him, and let him curse thus, because the Lord said to him to curse David, and who shall say, Why have you done thus?

11 And David said to Abessa and to all his servants, Behold, my son who came from my belly seeks my life, and still more now the son of the Jeminite; leave him to curse, because the Lord said it to him;

12 perhaps the Lord will look on my humiliation and return good to me instead of his curse on this day.

13 And David and his men went on the road, and Semei went beside the mountain next to him, going and cursing and stoning with stones at his side and sprinkling with dust.

14 And the king and all his people came exhausted and refreshed themselves there.

15 And Abessalom and every man of Israel entered Jerusalem, and Achitophel with him.

16 And it happened when Chousi the Archite, David's companion, came to Abessalom that Chousi said to Abessalom, Long live the king.

17 And Abessalom said to Chousi, Is this your mercy to your companion? Why did you not depart with your companion?

18 And Chousi said to Abessalom, No, but I shall be with the one whom the Lord and this people and every man of Israel chose, and sit with him;

19 and secondly, whom shall I serve? Is it not before his son? As I served before your father, so I shall be before you.

20 And Abessalom said to Achitophel, Bring counsel among yourselves about what we shall do.

21 And Achitophel said to Abessalom, Go in to your father's concubines whom he left to guard his house, and all Israel will hear that you have shamed your father, and the hands of all those with you will be strengthened.

22 And they pitched a tent for Abessalom on the roof, and Abessalom went in to his father's concubines before the eyes of all Israel.

23 And Achitophel's counsel, which he counseled in the former days, was as though one inquired by a word of God; so was all Achitophel's counsel both to David and to Abessalom. –

Chapter 17

1 And Achitophel said to Abessalom, Let me choose twelve thousand men for myself now, and I will rise and pursue after David by night;

2 and I will come upon him while he is weary and weak in his hands, and I will terrify him, and all the people with him will flee, and I will strike the king alone;

3 and I will turn all the people back to you in the way the bride returns to her husband; you seek only the life of one man, and there shall be peace for all the people.

4 And the word was right in the eyes of Abessalom and all the elders of Israel.

5 And Abessalom said, Call Chousi the Arachite too, and let us hear what is in his mouth also.

6 And Chousi entered to Abessalom; and Abessalom said to him, saying, According to this word Achitophel spoke; shall we do according to his word? If not, speak yourself.

7 And Chousi said to Abessalom, This counsel that Achitophel counseled is not good this time.

8 And Chousi said, You know your father and his men, that they are very mighty and bitter in their soul like a bear bereft of young in the field and like a rough pig in the plain, and your father is a warrior and will certainly not lodge with the people;

9 for behold, he is now hidden in one of the hills or in one of the places, and it shall be when he falls upon them at the start and one hearing hears and says, There has been a breaking among the people following Abessalom,

10 then even a son of strength whose heart is like a lion's heart will surely melt, because all Israel knows that your father is mighty and the sons of strength are with him.

11 For thus I counsel: Let all Israel surely gather to you from Dan to Bersabee as numerous as the sand on the sea, and let your face go in their midst,

12 and we shall come to him in one of the places where we find him there and encamp against him as the dew falls upon the land, and we shall leave neither him nor any one of the men with him;

13 and if he is gathered into a city, all Israel will take ropes to that city, and we shall drag it to the torrent bed so that not even a stone is left there.

14 And Abessalom and every man of Israel said, The counsel of Chousi the Arachite is better than Achitophel's counsel; and the Lord commanded that Achitophel's good counsel be scattered, so that the Lord might bring all the evils upon Abessalom. –

15 And Chousi the Arachite said to Saddok and Abiathar the priests, Thus and thus Achitophel counseled Abessalom and the elders of Israel, and thus and thus I counseled;

16 and now send quickly and tell David, saying, Do not spend the night in the plains of the wilderness, but hurry to cross over, lest he swallow up the king and all the people with him.

17 And Jonathan and Achimaas stood by the spring of Rogel, and the young woman went and told them, and they go and tell King David, because they could not be seen entering the city.

18 And a young man saw them and told Abessalom, and the two went quickly and entered a man's house in Baourim, and he had a cistern in the courtyard, and they went down there.

19 And the woman took and spread the covering over the mouth of the cistern and spread araphoth upon it, and nothing was known.

20 And Abessalom's servants came to the woman at the house and said, Where are Achimaas and Jonathan? And the woman said to them, They passed a little beyond the water; and they sought and did not find them and returned to Jerusalem.

21 And it happened after they departed that the two came up from the cistern and went and told King David and said to David, Rise and cross the water quickly, because Achitophel counseled thus concerning you.

22 And David and all the people with him rose and crossed the Jordan by the light of morning; not one escaped notice who had not crossed the Jordan.

23 And Achitophel saw that his counsel had not been followed, and saddled his donkey and rose and departed to his house in his city; and he commanded his house and hanged himself and died and was buried in his father's tomb.

24 And David passed into Manaim, and Abessalom crossed the Jordan, he and every man of Israel with him.

25 And Abessalom appointed Amessai over the army instead of Joab; and Amessai was the son of a man whose name was Jothor the Israelite, who went in to Abigaia daughter of Naas, sister of Sarouia, Joab's mother.

26 And all Israel and Abessalom encamped in the land of Galaad.

27 And it happened when David came to Manaim that Ouesbi son of Naas from Rabbath of the sons of Ammon and Machir son of Amiel from Lodabar and Berzelli the Galaadite from Rogellim

28 brought ten beds and rugs and ten cauldrons and earthen vessels and wheat and barley and flour and meal and beans and lentils

29 and honey and butter and sheep and sapphoth of cattle, and brought them for David and the people with him to eat, because they said, The people are hungry and weary and thirsty in the wilderness.

Chapter 18

1 And David mustered the people with him and appointed over them commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds,

2 and David sent the people, a third in Joab's hand and a third in the hand of Abessa son of Sarouia, Joab's brother, and a third in the hand of Etthi the Gethite. And David said to the people, I too shall surely go out with you.

3 And they said, You shall not go out, because if we flee, they will not set their heart upon us, and if half of us die, they will not set their heart upon us, because you are like ten thousand of us; and now it is good for you to be in the city as help to help us.

4 And the king said to them, Whatever is pleasing in your eyes I will do. And the king stood beside the gate, and all the people went out by hundreds and by thousands.

5 And the king commanded Joab and Abessa and Etthi, saying, Spare the young man Abessalom for me; and all the people heard the king commanding all the rulers concerning Abessalom.

6 And all the people went out into the forest opposite Israel, and the battle took place in the forest of Ephraim.

7 And Israel's people stumbled there before David's servants, and the breaking on that day was great, twenty thousand men.

8 And the battle there was scattered over the face of all the land, and the forest exceeded in devouring among the people those whom the sword devoured among the people on that day.

9 And Abessalom met before David's servants, and Abessalom was mounted on his mule, and the mule entered under the thicket of the great oak, and his head was caught in the oak, and he hung between heaven and earth, and the mule beneath him passed on.

10 And one man saw and reported to Joab and said, Behold, I have seen Abessalom hanging in the oak.

11 And Joab said to the man reporting, And behold, you saw; why did you not strike him to the ground? And I would have given you ten pieces of silver and one belt.

12 But the man said to Joab, Even if I stand upon my hands a thousand shekels of silver, I shall certainly not lay my hand upon the king's son, because in our ears the king commanded you and Abessa and Etthi, saying, Guard for me the young man Abessalom,

13 so as not to do wrong to his life; and no matter will be hidden from the king, and you would stand opposite.

14 And Joab said, I will begin this; I shall not remain thus before you. And Joab took three darts in his hand and fixed them in Abessalom's heart while he was still alive in the heart of the oak,

15 and ten young men carrying Joab's equipment surrounded and struck Abessalom and put him to death.

16 And Joab sounded the horn, and the people turned back from pursuing Israel, because Joab spared the people.

17 And he took Abessalom and threw him into a great chasm in the forest, into the great pit, and set up over him a very great heap of stones. And all Israel fled, each man to his dwelling.

18 And Abessalom while still alive had set up a pillar for himself, at which he was taken, and he erected it to take the pillar in the king's valley, because he said, He has no son to make his name remembered; and he called the pillar Hand of Abessalom until this day.

19 And Achimaas son of Saddok said, Let me run now and announce good news to the king that the Lord has judged for him from the hand of his enemies.

20 And Joab said to him, You are not a man of good news on this day, and you shall announce good news on another day, but on this day you shall not, because the king's son has died.

21 And Joab said to Chousi, Go and tell the king what you saw; and Chousi bowed to Joab and went out.

22 And Achimaas son of Saddok continued and said to Joab, And let it be that I too run after Chousi. And Joab said, Why do you run thus, my son? Come, there is no good news for your benefit in going.

23 And he said, For what if I run? And Joab said to him, Run. And Achimaas ran by the road of Kechar and passed Chousi. –

24 And David sat between the two gates. And the watchman went to the roof of the gate by the wall and raised his eyes and saw, and behold, a man running alone before him,

25 and the watchman cried out and told the king. And the king said, If he is alone, there is good news in his mouth. And he went on coming closer.

26 And the watchman saw another man running, and the watchman cried out at the gate and said, Behold, another man running alone. And the king said, This one too brings good news.

27 And the watchman said, I see the running of the first like the running of Achimaas son of Saddok. And the king said, This is a good man, and he will come with good news.

28 And Achimaas cried out and said to the king, Peace; and bowed to the king on his face to the ground; and said, Blessed be the Lord your God, who shut in the men who hated their hand against my lord the king.

29 And the king said, Is there peace for the young man Abessalom? And Achimaas said, I saw a great crowd when Joab sent the king's servant and your servant, and I did not know what was there.

30 And the king said, Turn aside, stand here; and he turned aside and stood.

31 And behold, Chousi arrived and said to the king, Let good news be announced to my lord the king, because the Lord has judged for you today from the hand of all those rising against you.

32 And the king said to Chousi, Is there peace for the young man Abessalom? And Chousi said, May the enemies of my lord the king and all those who rose against him for evil be like the young man.

Chapter 19

1 And the king was troubled and went up to the upper room of the gate and wept; and thus he said as he went, My son Abessalom, my son, my son Abessalom, who would give my death instead of you, I instead of you? Abessalom, my son, my son.

2 And it was reported to Joab, saying, Behold, the king weeps and mourns over Abessalom.

3 And the salvation on that day became mourning for all the people, because the people heard on that day, saying, The king grieves over his son.

4 And the people stole into the city on that day, as people steal in when ashamed as they flee in battle.

5 And the king covered his face, and the king cried with a great voice, saying, My son Abessalom, Abessalom my son.

6 And Joab came to the king into the house and said, Today you have shamed the faces of all your servants who delivered you today, and the lives of your sons and your daughters, and the lives of your wives and your concubines,

7 by loving those who hate you and hating those who love you; and today you have declared that your rulers and servants are nothing, for I have known today that if Abessalom were alive and all of us dead today, then it would have been right in your eyes.

8 And now arise, go out, and speak to the heart of your servants, for I have sworn by the Lord that if you do not go out today, if a man will lodge with you this night; and know for yourself that this will be worse for you than all the evil that has come upon you from your youth until now.

9 And the king arose and sat in the gate, and all the people were told, saying, Behold, the king sits in the gate; and all the people came before the king. And Israel fled, each man to his tent.

10 And all the people were disputing among all the tribes of Israel, saying, King David rescued us from all our enemies, and he delivered us from the hand of the foreigners, and now he has fled from the land and from his kingdom because of Abessalom.

11 And Abessalom, whom we anointed over us, died in the battle; and now why are you silent about bringing back the king? And the word of all Israel came to the king.

12 And King David sent to Sadok and Abiathar the priests, saying, Speak to the elders of Judah, saying, Why are you the last to bring the king back to his house? And the word of all Israel came to the king.

13 You are my brothers, my bones and my flesh you are; and why are you the last to bring the king back to his house?

14 And to Amessai you shall say, Are you not my bone and my flesh? And now may God do thus to me and thus add, if you are not commander of the force before me all the days instead of Joab.

15 And he inclined the heart of every man of Judah as one man, and they sent to the king, saying, Return, you and all your servants.

16 And the king returned and came as far as the Jordan, and the men of Judah came to Galgala to go to meet the king, to bring the king across the Jordan.

17 And Semei son of Gera, son of the Jemeni, from Baurim, hastened and went down with the man of Judah to meet King David,

18 and a thousand men with him from Benjamin, and Siba, the servant of the house of Saul, and his fifteen sons with him and his twenty servants with him; and they made their way to the Jordan ahead of the king

19 and performed the service of bringing the king across, and the crossing crossed over to move the king's household and to do what was right in his eyes. And Semei son of Gera fell on his face before the king as he crossed the Jordan

20 and said to the king, Let my lord not reckon lawlessness, and do not remember how your servant did wrong on the day when my lord the king went out from Jerusalem, so that the king should lay it to his heart,

21 because your servant knows that I sinned, and behold, I came today first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king.

22 And Abessa son of Sarouia answered and said, Shall Semei not be put to death for this, because he cursed the Lord's anointed?

23 And David said, What is there between me and you, sons of Sarouia, that you become an adversary to me today? Shall any man of Israel be put to death today? For do I not know that today I reign over Israel?

24 And the king said to Semei, You shall certainly not die; and the king swore to him.

25 And Memphibosthe son of Jonathan son of Saul went down to meet the king; and he had not cared for his feet, nor trimmed his nails, nor tended his mustache, nor washed his garments from the day the king departed until the day he arrived in peace.

26 And it happened when he came into Jerusalem to meet the king that the king said to him, Why did you not go with me, Memphibosthe?

27 And Memphibosthe said to him, My lord king, my servant deceived me, for your servant said to him, Saddle the donkey for me and I will mount it and go with the king, for your servant is lame.

28 And he schemed against your servant before my lord the king; and my lord the king is like an angel of God, so do what is good in your eyes.

29 For all my father's house was nothing but men of death to my lord the king, and you placed your servant among those eating at your table; and what right have I still, even to cry out any more to the king?

30 And the king said to him, Why do you still speak your words? I said, You and Siba shall divide the field.

31 And Memphibosthe said to the king, Let him indeed take everything, now that my lord the king has come in peace to his house.

32 And Berzelli the Galaadite came down from Rogellim and crossed the Jordan with the king to send him across the Jordan.

33 And Berzelli was a very old man, a son of eighty years, and he had sustained the king while he lived in Manaim, for he was a very great man.

34 And the king said to Berzelli, You shall cross with me, and I will sustain your old age with me in Jerusalem.

35 And Berzelli said to the king, How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem?

36 A son of eighty years am I today; shall I discern between good and evil? Or will your servant still taste what I eat or drink? Or will I still hear the voice of men and women singing? Why should your servant still be a burden upon my lord the king?

37 Your servant will cross the Jordan with the king for a little while; and why should the king repay me this recompense?

38 Let your servant stay, and I shall die in my city by the tomb of my father and my mother; and behold, your servant Chamaam shall cross with my lord the king, and do for him what is good in your eyes.

39 And the king said, Let Chamaam cross with me, and I will do for him what is good in your eyes, and all that you choose for me I will do for you.

40 And all the people crossed the Jordan, and the king crossed; and the king kissed Berzelli and blessed him, and he returned to his place.

41 And the king crossed to Galgala, and Chamaam crossed with him, and all the people of Judah crossed with the king, and indeed half the people of Israel.

42 And behold, every man of Israel came to the king and said to the king, Why have our brothers, the men of Judah, stolen you away and brought the king and his household across the Jordan, and all David's men with him?

43 And every man of Judah answered the man of Israel and said, Because the king is close to me; and why are you so angry over this matter? Have we eaten food from the king, or has he given a gift, or has he taken a levy for us?

44 And the man of Israel answered the man of Judah and said, I have ten shares in the king, and I am firstborn rather than you, and indeed I am above you in David; and why have you insulted me in this, and was my word not reckoned first for me to bring back the king for me? And the word of the man of Judah was harsher than the word of the man of Israel.

Chapter 20

1 And there was a lawless son there, one called Sabee son of Bochori, a man, the Jemeni; and he sounded the horn and said, We have no share in David, nor have we an inheritance in the son of Jessai. Each man to your tents, Israel.

2 And every man of Israel went up from following David after Sabee son of Bochori; and the man of Judah clung to their king from the Jordan as far as Jerusalem.

3 And David entered his house in Jerusalem, and the king took the ten women, his concubines whom he had left to guard the house, and placed them in a house of custody and sustained them, but did not go in to them; and they were confined until the day of their death, living widows.

4 And the king said to Amessai, Call together the man of Judah for me in three days, and you stand here.

5 And Amessai went to call together Judah and delayed beyond the time David had appointed for him.

6 And David said to Abessa, Now Sabee son of Bochori will do us more harm than Abessalom; and now take your lord's servants with you and pursue after him, lest he find fortified cities for himself and overshadow our eyes.

7 And the men of Joab went out after him, and the Chereththi and the Phelethi and all the mighty men; and they went out from Jerusalem to pursue after Sabee son of Bochori.

8 And they were by the great stone that is in Gabaon, and Amessai came before them. And Joab was girded with his cloak, his garment, and over it he was girded with a sword fastened at his waist in its sheath; and the sword came out and fell.

9 And Joab said to Amessai, Are you well, brother? And Joab's right hand took hold of Amessai's beard to kiss him.

10 And Amessai did not guard against the sword in Joab's hand, and Joab struck him with it in the flank, and his belly spilled onto the ground; and he did not strike him a second time, and he died. And Joab and Abessa his brother pursued after Sabee son of Bochori.

11 And one man of Joab's young servants stood by him and said, Whoever desires Joab and whoever is for David, after Joab!

12 And Amessai lay smeared in blood in the middle of the road, and the man saw that all the people stood still; and he turned Amessai out of the road into a field and threw a garment over him, because he saw everyone coming upon him stop.

13 And when he was removed from the road, every man of Israel passed on after Joab to pursue after Sabee son of Bochori.

14 And he passed through all the tribes of Israel to Abel and to Baithmacha and all in Charri; and they assembled and came after him.

15 And they arrived and besieged him in Abel and Baithmacha, and poured a siege mound against the city, and it stood at the outer wall; and all the people with Joab were thinking of throwing down the wall.

16 And a wise woman cried out from the wall and said, Hear, hear! Say now to Joab, Come near here and I will speak to him.

17 And he came near to her, and the woman said, Are you Joab? And he said, I am. And she said to him, Hear the words of your servant. And Joab said, I am listening.

18 And she said, saying, They spoke a word at the first, saying, They were surely asked in Abel and in Dan whether the things that the faithful of Israel had established had ceased; those asking shall surely ask in Abel, and thus whether they had ceased.

19 I am peaceable among the supports of Israel, but you seek to put to death a city and a mother-city in Israel; why do you sink the Lord's inheritance?

20 And Joab answered and said, Far be it from me, far be it from me, that I should sink or destroy it.

21 That is not the matter, for a man from the hill country of Ephraim, Sabee son of Bochori is his name, has raised his hand against King David. Give me him alone, and I will depart from above the city. And the woman said to Joab, Behold, his head will be thrown to you through the wall.

22 And the woman went in to all the people and spoke to the whole city in her wisdom; and she removed the head of Sabee son of Bochori and threw it to Joab. And he sounded the horn, and they scattered from the city, each man to his tent; and Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.

23 And Joab was over all the force of Israel, and Banaias son of Jodae over the Chereththi and over the Phelethi,

24 and Adoniram over the tribute, and Josaphat son of Achilouth as recorder,

25 and Sousa as scribe, and Sadok and Abiathar as priests,

26 and indeed Iras the Jarin was David's priest.

Chapter 21

1 And there was a famine in David's days for three years, one year following another, and David sought the face of the Lord. And the Lord said, Upon Saul and upon his house is wrongdoing, because of his death of bloods, for which he put the Gabaonites to death.

2 And King David called the Gabaonites and spoke to them; now the Gabaonites are not sons of Israel but rather from the remnant of the Amorite, and the sons of Israel had sworn to them; and Saul sought to strike them in his zeal for the sons of Israel and Judah.

3 And David said to the Gabaonites, What shall I do for you, and by what shall I make atonement, so that you may bless the Lord's inheritance?

4 And the Gabaonites said to him, We have no silver or gold with Saul and with his house, and we have no man to put to death in Israel. And he said, What do you say, and I shall do it for you?

5 And they said to the king, The man made an end of us and pursued us, he who schemed to destroy us; let us make him disappear so that he may not stand in any border of Israel.

6 Let seven men of his sons be given to us, and let us expose them to the sun for the Lord in Gabaon, Saul's chosen ones of the Lord. And the king said, I will give them.

7 And the king spared Memphibosthe son of Jonathan son of Saul because of the oath of the Lord between them, between David and Jonathan son of Saul.

8 And the king took the two sons of Respha daughter of Aia, whom she bore to Saul, Ermoni and Memphibosthe, and the five sons of Michol daughter of Saul, whom she bore to Esriel son of Berzelli the Moulathite,

9 and gave them into the hand of the Gabaonites, and they exposed them to the sun on the mountain before the Lord, and these seven fell together; and they were put to death in the days of harvest, at the first, at the beginning of the barley harvest.

10 And Respha daughter of Aia took sackcloth and fixed it for herself upon the rock at the beginning of the barley harvest, until water dripped upon them from heaven; and she did not allow the birds of heaven to rest upon them by day or the beasts of the field by night.

11 And it was reported to David what Respha daughter of Aia, Saul's concubine, had done, and they were loosened, and Dan son of Joa of the descendants of the giants overtook them.

12 And David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men, the sons of Jabis Galaad, who had stolen them from the square of Baithsan, because the foreigners had set them there on the day the foreigners struck Saul in Gelboue.

13 And he brought up from there the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son, and gathered the bones of those exposed to the sun.

14 And they buried the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son and of those exposed to the sun in the land of Benjamin, in the side, in the tomb of Kis his father, and they did all that the king commanded. And God listened to the land after these things.

15 And there was again war for the foreigners with Israel. And David and his servants with him went down and fought with the foreigners, and David grew faint.

16 And Jesbi, who was among the offspring of Rapha, and the weight of his spear was three hundred shekels in bronze weight, and he was girded with a club, and he intended to strike David.

17 And Abessa son of Sarouia helped him and struck the foreigner and put him to death. Then David's men swore, saying, You shall no longer go out with us to war, and you shall certainly not extinguish the lamp of Israel.

18 And after these things there was again war in Geth with the foreigners. Then Sebocha the Astatothite struck Seph, who was among the offspring of Rapha.

19 And there was war in Gob with the foreigners. And Eleanan son of Ariorgim the Bethlehemite struck Goliath the Gethite, and the shaft of his spear was like a weavers' beam.

20 And there was again war in Geth. And there was a man of great size, and the fingers of his hands and the toes of his feet were six and six, twenty-four in number; and he too was born to Rapha.

21 And he reproached Israel, and Jonathan son of Semei, David's brother, struck him.

22 These four were born as descendants of the giants in Geth to the house of Rapha, and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

Chapter 22

1 And David spoke to the Lord the words of this song on the day when the Lord delivered him from the hand of all his enemies and from the hand of Saul,

2 and he said, Lord, my rock and my fortress and my deliverer for me,

3 my God will be my guard; I will trust in him, my defender and the horn of my salvation, my helper and the refuge of my salvation; from the unjust you will save me.

4 I will call upon the Lord, who is praised, and I shall be saved from my enemies.

5 For the crushings of death encompassed me; torrents of lawlessness astonished me.

6 The pangs of death encircled me; the harshnesses of death came before me.

7 In my affliction I will call upon the Lord, and to my God I will cry out; and he will hear my voice from his temple, and my cry will be in his ears.

8 And the earth was troubled and shaken, and the foundations of heaven were troubled together and torn apart, because the Lord was angry with them.

9 Smoke went up in his anger, and fire from his mouth devours; coals were kindled from him.

10 And he bent the heavens and came down, and darkness was beneath his feet.

11 And he sat upon cherubim and flew, and was seen upon the wings of the wind.

12 And he made darkness his hiding place around him, his tent darkness of waters; he thickened it in the clouds of the air.

13 From the brightness before him coals of fire were kindled.

14 The Lord thundered from heaven, and the Most High gave his voice,

15 and sent arrows and scattered them, lightning and dismayed them.

16 And the outlets of the sea appeared, and the foundations of the inhabited world were uncovered at the rebuke of the Lord, at the breath of the spirit of his anger.

17 He sent from on high and took me; he drew me out of many waters.

18 He delivered me from my strong enemies, from those who hate me, because they were stronger than I.

19 They came before me in the day of my affliction, and the Lord became my support

20 and brought me out into a broad place and delivered me, because he took pleasure in me.

21 And the Lord repaid me according to my righteousness; according to the cleanness of my hands he repaid me,

22 because I kept the ways of the Lord and did not act impiously away from my God,

23 because all his judgments are before me, and his ordinances, I did not depart from them.

24 And I will be blameless toward him and guard against my lawlessness.

25 And the Lord will repay me according to my righteousness and according to the cleanness of my hands before his eyes.

26 With the holy you will be holy, and with the perfect man you will be perfect,

27 and with the chosen you will be chosen, and with the crooked you will be crooked.

28 And you will save the poor people, and you will humble eyes upon the exalted.

29 For you are my lamp, Lord, and the Lord will shine upon my darkness for me.

30 For in you I will run as one lightly girded, and in my God I will leap over a wall.

31 The strong one, his way is blameless; the word of the Lord is strong, refined by fire; he is a defender of all those who trust in him.

32 Who is strong besides the Lord? And who will be creator besides our God?

33 The strong one who strengthens me with power, and he shook out my way blameless;

34 setting my feet like those of deer and setting me upon the heights;

35 teaching my hands for war and breaking a bronze bow with my arm.

36 And you gave me the defense of my salvation, and your obedience made me great

37 into a broad place for my steps beneath me, and my legs were not shaken.

38 I will pursue my enemies and make them vanish, and I will not turn back until I finish them;

39 and I will crush them, and they will not rise, and they will fall beneath my feet.

40 And you will strengthen me with power for war; you will bend those who rise against me beneath me.

41 And you gave me my enemies' back, those who hate me, and you put them to death.

42 They will cry out, and there is no helper; to the Lord, and he did not hear them.

43 And I ground them like dust of the earth; like mud of the roads I made them fine.

44 And you will deliver me from the strife of peoples; you will keep me as head of nations; a people whom I did not know served me.

45 Foreign sons lied to me; at the hearing of the ear they listened to me.

46 Foreign sons will be cast away and will stumble out of their enclosures.

47 The Lord lives, and blessed is my guard, and exalted shall be my God, the guard of my salvation.

48 The Lord is strong, the one giving me acts of vengeance, disciplining peoples beneath me

49 and bringing me out from my enemies; and from those rising against me you will exalt me; from a man of wrongdoings you will deliver me.

50 Therefore I will confess you, Lord, among the nations, and to your name I will sing,

51 magnifying the salvations of his king and doing mercy to his anointed, to David and to his seed forever.

Chapter 23

1 And these are the last words of David: Faithful David son of Jessai, and a faithful man whom the Lord raised up as an anointed of the God of Jacob, and the beautiful psalms of Israel.

2 The spirit of the Lord spoke in me, and his word was upon my tongue.

3 The God of Israel says, the guard of Israel spoke to me: Speak a parable: In a man how will you strengthen fear of God?

4 And in God, with morning light the sun is to rise; the morning did not pass from brightness, and as from rain, grass from the earth.

5 For is not my house thus with the strong one? For he made an everlasting covenant for me, ready at every time, guarded, because all my salvation and every desire, for the lawless one shall certainly not sprout.

6 Like a thorn driven away are all of them, for they shall not be taken by hand,

7 and a man shall not toil among them, and a fullness of iron and a spear's shaft; and in fire by burning they shall be burned in their shame.

8 These are the names of David's mighty men: Jebosthe the Chananite is commander of the third, Adinon the Asonite. This one drew his sword against eight hundred wounded at once.

9 And after him Eleazar son of his father's brother, son of Sousitos, among the three mighty men. This one was with David in Serran; and when he reproached him among the foreigners, they gathered there for war, and the man of Israel went up.

10 He arose and struck among the foreigners until his hand grew weary and his hand clung to the sword, and the Lord made a great salvation on that day; and the people sat behind him except to strip the spoil.

11 And after him Samaia son of Asa the Arouchite. And the foreigners gathered at Theria, and there was a portion of the field full of lentils, and the people fled from before the foreigners.

12 And he stood firmly in the middle of the portion and delivered it and struck the foreigners, and the Lord made a great salvation.

13 And three of the thirty went down and came to Kason to David in the cave of Odollam, and a contingent of the foreigners encamped in the valley of Raphaim.

14 And David was then in the stronghold, and the garrison of the foreigners was then in Bethlehem.

15 And David desired and said, Who will give me water to drink from the pit in Bethlehem at the gate? And the assembly of the foreigners was then in Bethlehem.

16 And the three mighty men broke through the camp of the foreigners and drew water from the pit in Bethlehem at the gate and took it and came to David, and he did not wish to drink it and poured it out to the Lord

17 and said, Far be it from me, Lord, to do this; shall I drink the blood of the men who went at the risk of their lives? And he did not wish to drink it. These things the three mighty men did.

18 And Abessa brother of Joab son of Sarouia, he was a commander among the three; and he raised his spear against three hundred wounded, and he had a name among the three.

19 He was renowned among those three and became their commander, but he did not come up to the three.

20 And Banaias son of Jodae, himself a man of many deeds from Kabeseel. He struck the two sons of Ariel of Moab; and he went down and struck the lion in the middle of the pit on the day of snow.

21 He struck the Egyptian man, a conspicuous man, and in the Egyptian's hand was a spear like the wood of a ladder, and he went down to him with a staff and snatched the spear from the Egyptian's hand and killed him with his own spear.

22 These things Banaias son of Jodae did, and he had a name among the three mighty men.

23 He was renowned among the three, but did not come up to the three; and David appointed him to his hearings.

24 And these are the names of the mighty men of King David: Asael brother of Joab [this one was among the thirty], Eleanan son of Doudi, his father's brother, in Bethlehem,

25 Samai the Aroudaite, Elika the Arodaite,

26 Elles the Phelothite, Iras son of Ekkas the Thekoite,

27 Abiezer the Anathothite from the sons of the Asothite,

28 Selmon the Aoite, Moore the Netophathite,

29 Ela son of Baana the Netophathite, Eththi son of Riba from Gabaeth, son of Benjamin,

30 Banaias the Pharathonite, Ouri from Nachaligaias,

31 Abiel son of the Arabothite, Azmoth the Barsamite,

32 Eliasou the Salabonite, sons of Jasan, Jonathan,

33 Samma the Arodite, Achian son of Sarad the Araourite,

34 Aliphaleth son of the Asbite son of the Maachathite, Eliab son of Achitophel the Gelonite,

35 Asarai the Carmelite, Pharai the Erchite,

36 Igaal son of Nathan from the force, son of Gaddi,

37 Elie the Ammanite, Gelorai the Berothaite, bearer of the equipment of Joab son of Sarouia,

38 Iras the Jethiraite, Gareb the Jethiraite,

39 Ourias the Chettite, all thirty-seven.

Chapter 24

1 And the anger of the Lord continued to burn in Israel, and he stirred David against them, saying, Go, count Israel and Judah.

2 And the king said to Joab, the commander of the force who was with him, Go now through all the tribes of Israel from Dan as far as Bersabee and inspect the people, and I shall know the number of the people.

3 And Joab said to the king, May the Lord your God add to the people, as they are and as they are, a hundredfold, with the eyes of my lord the king seeing; and why does my lord the king desire this matter?

4 And the king's word prevailed over Joab and over the commanders of the force. And Joab and the commanders of the force went out from before the king to inspect the people of Israel.

5 And they crossed the Jordan and encamped in Aroer, to the right of the city that is in the middle of the ravine of Gad and Eliezer,

6 and came to Galaad and to the land of Thabason, which is Adasai, and arrived at Danidan and Oudan and went around to Sidon,

7 and came to Mapsar of Tyre and all the cities of the Evaite and the Chananite and came south of Judah to Bersabee,

8 and traveled around all the land and arrived in Jerusalem at the end of nine months and twenty days.

9 And Joab gave the number of the inspection of the people to the king, and Israel amounted to eight hundred thousand men of force drawing the sword, and the man of Judah to five hundred thousand fighting men.

10 And David's heart struck him after counting the people, and David said to the Lord, I have sinned greatly in what I have done; now, Lord, pass over the lawlessness of your servant, for I have acted very foolishly.

11 And David rose in the morning. And the word of the Lord came to Gad the prophet, David's seer, saying,

12 Go and speak to David, saying, Thus says the Lord: I am bringing three things upon you; choose for yourself one of them, and I shall do it to you.

13 And Gad came to David and reported to him and said to him, Choose for yourself what shall happen: whether three years of famine shall come upon you in your land, or you shall flee three months before your enemies and they shall pursue you, or three days of death shall occur in your land. Now then know and see what word I shall answer to the one who sent me.

14 And David said to Gad, It is very narrow for me on every side; let me fall into the hand of the Lord, for his mercies are very many, but into the hands of man I shall certainly not fall. And David chose death for himself.

15 And it was the days of wheat harvest, and the Lord gave death in Israel from morning until the hour of the meal, and the breaking began among the people, and seventy thousand men of the people died from Dan as far as Bersabee.

16 And the angel of God stretched out his hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it, and the Lord was moved concerning the evil and said to the angel who was destroying among the people, Enough now; relax your hand. And the angel of the Lord was by the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite.

17 And David spoke to the Lord when he saw the angel striking among the people and said, Behold, it is I who have done wrong, and I, the shepherd, have done evil; but these sheep, what have they done? Let your hand be upon me and upon my father's house.

18 And Gad came to David on that day and said to him, Go up and set up an altar to the Lord on the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite.

19 And David went up according to Gad's word, in the manner the Lord commanded him.

20 And Orna looked out and saw the king and his servants passing above him, and Orna went out and bowed before the king with his face to the ground.

21 And Orna said, Why has my lord the king come to his servant? And David said, To acquire from you the threshing floor to build an altar to the Lord, so that the breaking upon the people may be held back.

22 And Orna said to David, Let my lord the king take and offer to the Lord what is good in his eyes; behold, the oxen for a whole burnt offering, and the wheels and the equipment of the oxen for wood.

23 Orna gave everything to the king, and Orna said to the king, May the Lord your God bless you.

24 And the king said to Orna, No, but I shall certainly acquire it from you in exchange, and I shall not offer to the Lord my God a whole burnt offering for nothing. And David acquired the threshing floor and the oxen for fifty shekels of silver.

25 And David built an altar there to the Lord and offered whole burnt offerings and peace offerings; and Solomon added to the altar later, for it was small at first. And the Lord listened to the land, and the breaking was held back from over Israel.

1 Kings

Chapter 1

1 And King David was old, advanced in days, and they covered him with garments, but he was not warmed.

2 And his servants said, Let them seek a young virgin for our lord the king, and she shall stand before the king and warm him and lie with him, and our lord the king shall be warmed.

3 And they sought a beautiful young woman from every border of Israel and found Abisak the Somanite and brought her to the king.

4 And the young woman was very beautiful; and she warmed the king and ministered to him, but the king did not know her.

5 And Adonias son of Aggith exalted himself, saying, I shall reign; and he made himself chariots and horsemen and fifty men to run before him.

6 And his father had never restrained him, saying, Why have you done this? And indeed he was very handsome in appearance, and she bore him after Abessalom.

7 And his words were with Joab son of Sarouia and with Abiathar the priest, and they helped, following Adonias.

8 But Sadok the priest and Banaias son of Jodae and Nathan the prophet and Semei and Rei and David's mighty men were not following Adonias.

9 And Adonias sacrificed sheep and calves and lambs by the stone of Zoelet, which was next to the spring of Rogel, and called all his brothers and all the prominent men of Judah, servants of the king.

10 But Nathan the prophet and Banaias and the mighty men and Solomon his brother he did not call.

11 And Nathan said to Bersabee, Solomon's mother, saying, Have you not heard that Adonias son of Aggith has become king? And our lord David did not know.

12 And now come, let me advise you with counsel, and you shall deliver your life and the life of your son Solomon.

13 Come, go in to King David and say to him, Did you not, my lord king, swear to your servant, saying, Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne? Why then has Adonias become king?

14 And behold, while you are still speaking there with the king, I shall come in after you and complete your words.

15 And Bersabee went in to the king in the chamber, and the king was very old, and Abisak the Somanite was ministering to the king.

16 And Bersabee bowed and prostrated herself before the king. And the king said, What is it for you?

17 And she said, My lord king, you swore by the Lord your God to your servant, saying, Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit on my throne.

18 And now behold, Adonias has become king, and you, my lord king, did not know.

19 And he sacrificed calves and lambs and sheep in abundance and called all the king's sons and Abiathar the priest and Joab the commander of the force, but Solomon your servant he did not call.

20 And you, my lord king, the eyes of all Israel are toward you to tell them who shall sit upon the throne of my lord the king after him.

21 And it shall be, when my lord the king lies down with his fathers, that I and my son Solomon shall be sinners.

22 And behold, while she was still speaking with the king, Nathan the prophet came.

23 And it was reported to the king, Behold, Nathan the prophet. And he came before the king and prostrated himself before the king with his face to the ground.

24 And Nathan said, My lord king, did you say, Adonias shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne?

25 For he went down today and sacrificed calves and lambs and sheep in abundance and called all the king's sons and the commanders of the force and Abiathar the priest, and behold, they are eating and drinking before him and have said, Long live King Adonias.

26 But me, your servant, and Sadok the priest and Banaias son of Jodae and Solomon your servant he did not call.

27 Has this matter come about through my lord the king, and have you not made known to your servant who shall sit upon the throne of my lord the king after him?

28 And David answered and said, Call Bersabee for me. And she came before the king and stood before him.

29 And the king swore and said, As the Lord lives, who redeemed my life from every affliction,

30 as I swore to you by the Lord God of Israel, saying, Solomon your son shall reign after me, and he shall sit upon my throne instead of me, so I shall do this day.

31 And Bersabee bowed with her face to the ground and prostrated herself before the king and said, May my lord King David live forever.

32 And King David said, Call Sadok the priest and Nathan the prophet and Banaias son of Jodae for me. And they came before the king.

33 And the king said to them, Take your lord's servants with you and put my son Solomon upon my mule and bring him down to Gion.

34 And let Sadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anoint him there as king over Israel, and sound the horn and say, Long live King Solomon.

35 And he shall sit upon my throne and he shall reign instead of me, and I have commanded that he be leader over Israel and Judah.

36 And Banaias son of Jodae answered the king and said, So be it; thus may the Lord God of my lord the king confirm it.

37 As the Lord was with my lord the king, so may he be with Solomon and make his throne greater than the throne of my lord King David.

38 And Sadok the priest and Nathan the prophet and Banaias son of Jodae and the Chereththi and the Phelethi went down and seated Solomon on King David's mule and led him to Gion.

39 And Sadok the priest took the horn of oil from the tent and anointed Solomon and sounded the horn, and all the people said, Long live King Solomon.

40 And all the people went up after him and danced in dances and rejoiced with great joy, and the earth split with their sound.

41 And Adonias and all his invited guests heard, as they finished eating; and Joab heard the sound of the horn and said, What is the sound of the city resounding?

42 While he was still speaking, behold, Jonathan son of Abiathar the priest came, and Adonias said, Come in, for you are a man of strength, and bring good news.

43 And Jonathan answered and said, Indeed, our lord King David has made Solomon king.

44 And the king sent with him Sadok the priest and Nathan the prophet and Banaias son of Jodae and the Chereththi and the Phelethi, and they seated him on the king's mule.

45 And Sadok the priest and Nathan the prophet anointed him as king at Gion, and they went up from there rejoicing, and the city resounded; that is the sound you heard.

46 And Solomon sat upon the throne of the kingdom.

47 And the king's servants came in to bless our lord King David, saying, May God make the name of Solomon your son better than your name and make his throne greater than your throne. And the king prostrated himself upon his bed.

48 And indeed the king said thus, Blessed is the Lord God of Israel, who today gave one of my seed sitting upon my throne, and my eyes see it.

49 And all those invited by Adonias were astonished and rose up and went, each man on his way.

50 And Adonias feared Solomon's face and arose and went and took hold of the horns of the altar.

51 And it was reported to Solomon, saying, Behold, Adonias fears King Solomon and holds the horns of the altar, saying, Let King Solomon swear to me today that he will not put his servant to death by the sword.

52 And Solomon said, If he becomes a son of strength, will a hair of his fall to the ground? But if evil is found in him, he shall be put to death.

53 And King Solomon sent and brought him down from above the altar; and he came in and prostrated himself before King Solomon, and Solomon said to him, Go to your house.

Chapter 2

1 And the days drew near for David to die, and he commanded Solomon his son, saying,

2 I am going in the way of all the earth; be strong and become a man,

3 and keep the charge of the Lord your God, to walk in his ways, to keep his commandments and the ordinances and the judgments written in the law of Moses, so that you may understand what you shall do in everything that I command you,

4 so that the Lord may establish his word which he spoke, saying, If your sons keep their way to walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, saying, A man of yours shall not be cut off from upon the throne of Israel.

5 And indeed you know what Joab son of Sarouia did to me, what he did to the two commanders of the forces of Israel, to Abenner son of Ner and Amessai son of Jether, and he killed them and placed the bloods of war in peace and put innocent blood upon his belt at his waist and upon his sandal on his foot.

6 And you shall act according to your wisdom and shall not bring his gray hair down to Hades in peace.

7 And to the sons of Berzelli the Galaadite you shall show mercy, and they shall be among those eating at your table, because so they drew near to me when I fled from before Abessalom your brother.

8 And behold, with you is Semei son of Gera son of the Jemeni from Baurim, and he cursed me with a grievous curse on the day when I went to the Camps, and he went down to meet me at the Jordan, and I swore to him by the Lord, saying, If I put you to death by the sword.

9 And you shall certainly not hold him innocent, for you are a wise man and shall know what you shall do to him, and you shall bring his gray hair down to Hades in blood.

10 And David lay down with his fathers and was buried in the city of David.

11 And the days that David reigned over Israel were forty years; in Hebron he reigned seven years and in Jerusalem thirty-three years.

12 And Solomon sat upon the throne of David his father, being a son of twelve years, and his kingdom was made very firm.

13 And Adonias son of Aggith went in to Bersabee, Solomon's mother, and bowed to her. And she said, Is your coming peaceful? And he said, Peaceful.

14 I have a word for you. And she said to him, Speak.

15 And he said to her, You know that the kingdom was mine and all Israel set its face toward me as king, but the kingdom turned and became my brother's, because it became his from the Lord.

16 And now I ask one request of you; do not turn away your face. And Bersabee said to him, Speak.

17 And he said to her, Say now to King Solomon, for he will not turn away his face from you, and he shall give me Abisak the Somanite as wife.

18 And Bersabee said, Good; I shall speak about you to the king.

19 And Bersabee went in to King Solomon to speak to him about Adonias. And the king rose to meet her and kissed her and sat upon his throne, and a throne was set for the king's mother and she sat at his right.

20 And she said to him, I ask one small request of you; do not turn away your face. And the king said to her, Ask, my mother, for I shall not turn you away.

21 And she said, Let Abisak the Somanite be given to Adonias your brother as wife.

22 And King Solomon answered and said to his mother, And why did you ask for Abisak for Adonias? Ask the kingdom for him too, for he is my older brother, and for him are Abiathar the priest and Joab son of Sarouia, the commander in chief, as a companion.

23 And King Solomon swore by the Lord, saying, May God do thus to me and thus add, for against his own life Adonias spoke this word.

24 And now, as the Lord lives, who established me and placed me upon the throne of David my father and made me a house, as the Lord spoke, Adonias shall be put to death today.

25 And King Solomon sent by the hand of Banaias son of Jodae, and he killed him, and Adonias died on that day.

26 And to Abiathar the priest the king said, Go away to Anathoth, to your field, for you are a man of death on this day; but I shall not put you to death, because you carried the ark of the covenant of the Lord before my father, and because you were afflicted in all that my father was afflicted.

27 And Solomon drove Abiathar out from being a priest of the Lord, to fulfill the word of the Lord which he spoke against the house of Eli in Selom.

28 And the report reached Joab son of Sarouia [for Joab had inclined after Adonias, but after Solomon he had not inclined], and Joab fled to the tent of the Lord and held onto the horns of the altar.

29 And it was reported to Solomon, saying, Joab has fled to the tent of the Lord, and behold, he holds the horns of the altar. And Solomon sent to Joab, saying, What has happened to you, that you have fled to the altar? And Joab said, Because I feared your face, and I fled to the Lord. And King Solomon sent Banaias son of Jodae, saying, Go and kill him and bury him.

30 And Banaias son of Jodae came to Joab in the tent of the Lord and said to him, Thus says the king: Come out. And Joab said, I shall not go out, for here I shall die. And Banaias son of Jodae returned and told the king, saying, Thus Joab has spoken, and thus he answered me.

31 And the king said to him, Go and do to him as he has said, and kill him and bury him, and remove today the blood that Joab shed without cause from me and from my father's house.

32 And the Lord has returned the blood of his wrongdoing upon his head, since he met the two men more righteous and better than he and killed them by the sword, and my father David did not know of their blood: Abenner son of Ner, commander in chief of Israel, and Amessa son of Jether, commander in chief of Judah.

33 And their blood shall return upon his head and upon the head of his seed forever, but to David and to his seed and to his house and to his throne may there be peace forever from the Lord.

34 And Banaias son of Jodae met Joab and put him to death and buried him in his house in the wilderness.

35 And the king placed Banaias son of Jodae in his place over the command of the army; and the kingdom was established in Jerusalem; and the king placed Sadok the priest as first priest instead of Abiathar.

35 And the Lord gave Solomon understanding and very great wisdom and breadth of heart like the sand beside the sea,

36 and Solomon's understanding greatly increased beyond the understanding of all the ancient sons and beyond all the wise men of Egypt.

37 And he took Pharaoh's daughter and brought her into the city of David until he completed his house and the house of the Lord at first and the wall of Jerusalem all around; in seven years he made and completed it.

36 And Solomon had seventy thousand burden bearers and eighty thousand stonecutters in the mountain.

37 And Solomon made the sea and the supports and the great basins and the pillars and the fountain of the courtyard and the bronze sea.

38 And he built the citadel and its battlements and cut through the city of David; thus Pharaoh's daughter went up from the city of David to her house, which he built for her; then he built the citadel.

39 And Solomon offered whole burnt offerings and peace offerings three times a year upon the altar which he built for the Lord, and burned incense before the Lord. And he completed the house.

40 And these are the officers appointed over Solomon's works: three thousand six hundred overseers of the people doing the work.

41 And he built Assour and Magdo and Gazer and upper Baithoron and Baalath.

35 But after he built the house of the Lord and the wall of Jerusalem around it, after these things he built these cities.

36 And while David was still alive he commanded Solomon, saying, Behold, with you is Semei son of Gera, son of the seed of the Jemeni, from Hebron.

37 This one cursed me with a grievous curse on the day when I went to the Camps.

38 And he came down to meet me at the Jordan, and I swore to him by the Lord, saying, If he shall be put to death by the sword.

39 And now do not hold him innocent, for you are a prudent man and shall know what you shall do to him, and you shall bring his gray hair down to Hades in blood.

36 And the king called Semei and said to him, Build yourself a house in Jerusalem and dwell there, and you shall not go out from there anywhere.

37 And it shall be on the day you go out and cross the brook Kedron, you shall surely know that you shall die by death; your blood shall be upon your head. And the king made him swear on that day.

38 And Semei said to the king, The word you have spoken is good, my lord king; thus your servant shall do. And Semei dwelt in Jerusalem three years.

39 And after three years two servants of Semei ran away to Anchous son of Maacha, king of Geth, and Semei was told, Behold, your servants are in Geth.

40 And Semei arose and saddled his donkey and went to Geth to Anchous to seek his servants, and Semei went and brought his servants from Geth.

41 And Solomon was told, saying, Semei went from Jerusalem to Geth and brought back his servants.

42 And the king sent and called Semei and said to him, Did I not make you swear by the Lord and testify to you, saying, On whatever day you go out from Jerusalem and go to the right or to the left, you shall surely know that you shall die by death?

43 And why did you not keep the oath of the Lord and the commandment that I commanded you?

44 And the king said to Semei, You know all your evil which your heart knew, which you did to David my father, and the Lord has repaid your evil upon your head.

45 And King Solomon is blessed, and David's throne shall be established before the Lord forever.

46 And King Solomon commanded Banaias son of Jodae, and he went out and killed him, and he died.

46 And King Solomon was very prudent and wise, and Judah and Israel were very many, like the sand upon the sea in multitude, eating and drinking and rejoicing.

47 And Solomon was ruler in all the kingdoms, and they brought gifts and served Solomon all the days of his life.

48 And Solomon began to open the dominions of Lebanon,

49 and he built Thermai in the wilderness.

50 And this was Solomon's meal: thirty kors of fine flour and sixty kors of ground flour, ten choice calves and twenty pasture oxen and a hundred sheep, besides deer and gazelles and choice pastured birds.

51 For he was ruler in all beyond the river, from Raphi to Gaza, over all the kings beyond the river.

52 And he had peace from all his parts around him, and Judah and Israel dwelt trusting, each under his vine and under his fig tree, eating and drinking, from Dan as far as Bersabee all the days of Solomon.

53 And these were Solomon's officers: Azarion son of Sadok the priest, and Orniou son of Nathan commander of the overseers, and Edram over his house, and Souba the scribe, and Basa son of Achithalam the recorder, and Abi son of Joab commander in chief, and Achire son of Edrai over the burdens, and Banaias son of Jodae over the court command and over the brickworks, and Zachour son of Nathan the counselor.

54 And Solomon had forty thousand brood mares for chariots and twelve thousand horsemen.

Chapter 3

1 And when the kingdom was established in Solomon's hand, Solomon made a marriage alliance with Pharaoh king of Egypt and took Pharaoh's daughter and brought her into the city of David, until he completed building his own house and the house of the Lord and the wall around Jerusalem.

2 But the people were burning incense on the high places, because a house had not yet been built for the name of the Lord.

3 And Solomon loved the Lord, walking in the ordinances of David his father, but he sacrificed and burned incense on the high places.

4 And he arose and went to Gabaon to sacrifice there, for it was the highest and great; Solomon offered a thousand whole burnt offerings upon the altar in Gabaon.

5 And the Lord appeared to Solomon in sleep at night, and the Lord said to Solomon, Ask some request for yourself.

6 And Solomon said, You showed great mercy to your servant David my father, as he walked before you in truth and in righteousness and in uprightness of heart with you, and you kept this great mercy for him, to give his son upon his throne, as on this day.

7 And now, Lord my God, you placed your servant instead of David my father, and I am a small child and do not know my going out and my coming in.

8 And your servant is in the midst of your people whom you chose, a numerous people who shall not be counted.

9 And give your servant a heart to hear and to judge your people in righteousness, to understand between good and evil; for who will be able to judge this weighty people of yours?

10 And it was pleasing before the Lord that Solomon asked this matter.

11 And the Lord said to him, Because you asked this matter of me and did not ask for yourself many days and did not ask for riches or for the lives of your enemies, but asked for yourself understanding to hear judgment,

12 behold, I have done according to your word; behold, I have given you a prudent and wise heart, such that one like you has not existed before you and one like you shall not arise after you.

13 And what you did not ask, I have given you, both riches and glory, such that no man like you has existed among kings.

14 And if you walk in my way to keep my commandments and my ordinances, as David your father walked, then I shall multiply your days.

15 And Solomon awoke, and behold, it was a dream; and he arose and came to Jerusalem and stood before the altar before the ark of the Lord's covenant in Sion and offered whole burnt offerings and made peace offerings and made a great feast for himself and all his servants.

16 Then two women, prostitutes, appeared before the king and stood before him.

17 And the one woman said, With me, lord; I and this woman dwell in one house, and we gave birth in the house.

18 And it happened on the third day after I gave birth that this woman also gave birth; and we were together, and there was no one with us besides the two of us in the house.

19 And this woman's son died in the night when she lay upon him.

20 And she arose in the middle of the night and took my son from my arms and laid him in her bosom, and her dead son she laid in my bosom.

21 And I arose in the morning to nurse my son, and he was dead; and behold, I examined him in the morning, and behold, he was not my son whom I bore.

22 And the other woman said, No, but my son is the living one, and your son is the dead one. And they spoke before the king.

23 And the king said to them, You say, This is my living son, and hers is the dead son; and you say, No, but my son is the living one, and yours is the dead son.

24 And the king said, Bring me a sword; and they brought the sword before the king.

25 And the king said, Divide the living nursing child in two and give half of him to this one and half of him to this one.

26 And the woman whose son was the living one answered and said to the king, because her womb was troubled over her son, and said, With me, lord, give her the child and do not put him to death; and the other said, Let him be neither mine nor hers; divide him.

27 And the king answered and said, Give the child to the one who said, Give him to her and do not put him to death; she is his mother.

28 And all Israel heard this judgment which the king judged, and they feared before the king, because they saw that God's understanding was in him to do justice.

Chapter 4

1 And King Solomon was reigning over Israel.

2 And these were his officers: Azariou son of Sadok,

3 and Eliareph and Achia son of Saba, scribes, and Josaphat son of Achilid, recorder,

4 and Sadouch and Abiathar, priests,

5 and Ornia son of Nathan over the appointees, and Zabouth son of Nathan, companion of the king,

6 and Achiel, steward, and Eliab son of Saph over the family, and Adoniram son of Ephra over the tributes.

7 And Solomon had twelve appointees over all Israel to provide for the king and his house; one month in the year fell to each one to provide.

8 And these are their names: Benor in the hill country of Ephraim, one;

9 son of Rechab in Machemas and Bethalamin and Baithsamys and Ailon as far as Baithanan, one;

10 son of Esoth in Berbethnema, Lousamencha and Resphara;

11 Chinanadab and Anaphathi, husband of Tableth, Solomon's daughter, who was his wife, one;

12 Bakcha son of Achilid, Thaanach and Mekedo and all the house of San beside Sesathan below Esrae, and from Baisaphoud Ebelmaola as far as Maeber Loukam, one;

13 son of Gaber in Remath Galaad, to him was allotted Eregaba, which is in Basan, sixty great walled cities with bronze bars, one;

14 Achinadab son of Achel in Maanain, one;

15 Achimaas in Nephthali, and he took Basemmath daughter of Solomon as wife, one;

16 Baana son of Chousi in Maalath, one;

17 Samaa son of Ela in Benjamin;

18 Gaber son of Adai in the land of Gad, the land of Seon king of Esebon and Og king of Basan; and one nasiph in the land of Judah;

19 Josaphat son of Phouasoud in Issachar.

Chapter 5

1 And the appointees thus provided for King Solomon and every order for the king's table, each in his month, not departing from the word; and they carried barley and straw for the horses and chariots to the place where the king would be, each according to his assignment.

2 And these were Solomon's daily requirements: thirty kors of fine flour and sixty kors of ground flour,

3 and ten choice calves and twenty pasture oxen and a hundred sheep, besides deer and gazelles and choice fattened birds.

4 For he was ruler beyond the river, and he had peace from all the parts around him.

9 And the Lord gave Solomon understanding and very great wisdom and an outpouring of heart like the sand beside the sea,

10 and Solomon greatly increased beyond the understanding of all ancient men and beyond all the wise men of Egypt,

11 and he became wiser than all men and wiser than Gaithan the Ezraite and Aiman and Chalkal and Darda, sons of Mal.

12 And Solomon spoke three thousand parables, and his songs were five thousand.

13 And he spoke about trees, from the cedar in Lebanon as far as the hyssop growing through the wall, and he spoke about beasts and about birds and about creeping things and about fish.

14 And all the peoples came to hear Solomon's wisdom, and he received gifts from all the kings of the earth who heard his wisdom.

14 And Solomon took Pharaoh's daughter for himself as wife and brought her into the city of David until he completed the house of the Lord and his own house and the wall of Jerusalem.

15 Then Pharaoh king of Egypt went up and seized Gazer beforehand and burned it and the Chananite living in Mergab, and Pharaoh gave them as a dispatch to his daughter, Solomon's wife, and Solomon built Gazer. And Chiram king of Tyre sent his servants to anoint Solomon instead of David his father, for Chiram loved David all the days.

16 And Solomon sent to Chiram, saying,

17 You know that David my father was not able to build a house for the name of the Lord my God because of the wars that surrounded him, until the Lord put them under the tracks of his feet.

18 And now the Lord my God has given me rest all around; there is no adversary and no evil occurrence.

19 And behold, I say I shall build a house for the name of the Lord my God, as the Lord God spoke to David my father, saying, Your son whom I shall place instead of you upon your throne, he shall build the house for my name.

20 And now command them to cut wood for me from Lebanon, and behold, my servants will be with your servants; and I shall give you the wages for your service according to everything you say, for you know that there is no one among us who knows how to cut wood like the Sidonians.

21 And it happened when Chiram heard Solomon's words that he rejoiced greatly and said, Blessed is God today, who gave David a prudent son over this numerous people.

22 And he sent to Solomon, saying, I have heard concerning all that you sent to me; I shall do all your desire concerning cedar and pine wood.

23 My servants shall bring it down from Lebanon to the sea, and I shall set it in rafts as far as the place to which you send me, and I shall unload it there, and you shall take it; and you shall do my desire, to give bread to my house.

24 And Chiram was giving Solomon cedars and all his desire.

25 And Solomon gave Chiram twenty thousand kors of wheat and machir for his house and twenty thousand baths of beaten oil; thus Solomon gave to Chiram each year.

26 And the Lord gave Solomon wisdom, as he spoke to him; and there was peace between Chiram and Solomon, and they made a covenant between themselves.

27 And the king raised a levy from all Israel, and the levy was thirty thousand men.

28 And he sent them to Lebanon, ten thousand in a month, alternating; one month they were in Lebanon and two months in their house; and Adoniram was over the levy.

29 And Solomon had seventy thousand burden bearers and eighty thousand stonecutters in the mountain,

30 apart from the officers appointed over Solomon's works, three thousand six hundred overseers who did the works.

32 And they prepared the stones and the wood for three years.

Chapter 6

1 And it happened in the four hundred and fortieth year of the departure of the sons of Israel from Egypt, in the fourth year, in the second month, while King Solomon reigned over Israel,

1 and the king commanded, and they brought large precious stones for the foundation of the house and hewn stones.

2 And Solomon's sons and Chiram's sons hewed them and laid them.

3 In the fourth year he laid the foundation of the house of the Lord in the month Niso, the second month.

4 In the eleventh year, in the month Baal [this is the eighth month], the house was completed according to every word of it and according to all its arrangement.

2 And the house which King Solomon built for the Lord was forty cubits in length and twenty cubits in width and twenty-five cubits in height.

3 And the aelam before the temple was twenty cubits in length along the width of the house and ten cubits in width before the house. And he built the house and completed it.

4 And he made for the house concealed projecting windows.

5 And he placed beams around the wall of the house for the temple and for the dabir, and made side chambers around it.

6 The lower side chamber was five cubits in width, and the middle six, and the third seven cubits in width; for he made an offset around the house outside it so that they would not take hold of the walls of the house.

7 And the house, while it was being built, was built with rough quarried stones, and hammer and axe and every iron tool were not heard in the house while it was being built.

8 And the entrance of the lower side chamber was beneath the right shoulder of the house, and there was a winding ascent to the middle and from the middle to the three stories.

9 And he built the house and completed it; and he fitted the house with cedar.

10 And he built the bindings throughout the house, five cubits in height, and fastened the binding with cedar timbers.

15 And he built the walls of the house with cedar timbers from the floor of the house as far as the beams and as far as the walls; he fitted them continuously with wood inside and enclosed the interior of the house with pine sides.

16 And he built the twenty cubits at the end of the house, the one side from the floor to the beams, and made it from the dabir into the holy of holies.

17 And the temple was forty cubits before

19 the dabir in the middle of the house within, to place there the ark of the covenant of the Lord.

20 Twenty cubits was its length and twenty cubits its width and twenty cubits its height, and he covered it with enclosed gold. And he made an altar

21 before the dabir and covered it with gold.

22 And he covered the entire house with gold until all the house was completed.

23 And he made two cherubim in the dabir, each ten cubits in measured size.

24 And one wing of the one cherub was five cubits and its second wing five cubits, ten cubits from the edge of its wing to the edge of its wing.

25 So also for the second cherub; there was one measure and one completion for both.

26 And the height of the one cherub was ten cubits, and so was the second cherub.

27 And both cherubim were in the middle of the innermost house; and he spread out their wings, and one wing touched the wall and a wing touched the second wall, and their wings in the middle of the house touched wing to wing.

28 And he covered the cherubim with gold.

29 And all the walls of the house around he inscribed with a stylus, with carved cherubim and palm trees inside and outside.

30 And he covered the floor of the house with gold, of the innermost and of the outermost.

31 And for the doorway of the dabir he made doors of juniper wood and fivefold doorposts,

32 and two doors of pine wood, with carvings upon them, carved cherubim and palm trees and spread-out petals; and he covered them with gold, and the gold came down upon the cherubim and the palm trees.

33 And thus he made for the entrance of the temple, doorposts of juniper wood, fourfold porticoes.

34 And in both doors there was pine wood; two folds of the one door and their pivots, and two folds of the second door, turning.

35 Carved cherubim and palm trees and spread-out petals, covered with gold drawn down upon the relief.

36 And he built the inner courtyard, three courses of hewn stones and a course of worked cedar around it.

36 And he built a curtain for the courtyard of the aelam of the house before the temple.

Chapter 7

1 And King Solomon sent and took Chiram from Tyre,

2 the son of a widowed woman, who was of the tribe of Nephthali, and his father was a Tyrian man, a worker in bronze, and he was filled with skill and understanding and knowledge to make every work in bronze; and he was brought to King Solomon and made all the works.

3 And he cast the two pillars for the aelam of the house; eighteen cubits was the height of a pillar, and a circumference of fourteen cubits surrounded it, and the thickness of the pillar was four fingers in its hollows, and so was the second pillar.

4 And he made two capitals to place upon the heads of the pillars, cast bronze; the height of the one capital was five cubits, and the height of the second capital was five cubits.

5 And he made two nets to cover the capitals of the pillars, a net for the one capital and a net for the second capital.

6 And hanging work, two rows of bronze pomegranates netted, hanging work, row upon row; and so he made for the second capital.

7 And he set up the pillars of the aelam of the temple; and he set up the one pillar and called its name Jachoum, and he set up the second pillar and called its name Baaz.

8 And on the heads of the pillars was lily work along the aelam, four cubits.

9 And a beam was upon both pillars, and above the sides was the capital, the beam in its thickness.

10 And he made the sea, ten cubits from its lip to its lip, round all around; its height was five cubits, and thirty-three cubits gathered together encircled it.

11 And supports beneath its lip surrounded it all around, ten to a cubit all around, to raise the sea.

12 And its lip was like the work of the lip of a cup, a lily shoot, and its thickness a handbreadth.

13 And twelve oxen were beneath the sea, three facing north and three facing the sea and three facing south and three facing east, and all their hind parts toward the house, and the sea above upon them.

14 And he made ten bronze mechonoth; one mechonoth was five cubits long and four cubits wide and six cubits high.

15 And this was the work of the mechonoth: they had enclosures, and enclosures between the projecting parts.

16 And on their enclosures between the projecting parts were lions and oxen and cherubim, and on the projecting parts likewise; and above and below the lions and oxen were spaces, work of a descent.

17 And four bronze wheels belonged to each mechonoth, and the adjoining parts were bronze, and their four parts were shoulders beneath the basins.

18 And there were arms among the wheels in the mechonoth, and the height of one wheel was a cubit and a half.

19 And the work of the wheels was the work of chariot wheels; their arms and their backs and their workmanship were all cast.

20 The four shoulders on the four corners of each mechonoth, its shoulders were from the mechonoth.

21 And upon the head of the mechonoth was a round size of half a cubit all around upon the head of the mechonoth, and the beginnings of its arms and its enclosures, and it was opened upon the beginnings of its arms.

22 And its enclosures had cherubim and lions and palm trees standing, each adjoining what faced it inside and around.

23 According to it he made all ten mechonoth, one arrangement and one measure for all.

24 And he made ten bronze chytrokauloi, each one holding forty choes by measure; one chytrokaulos upon each mechonoth for the ten mechonoth.

25 And he placed the ten mechonoth, five by the right shoulder of the house and five by the left shoulder of the house; and the sea by the right shoulder of the house toward the east, from the southern side.

26 And Chiram made the cauldrons and the heating vessels and the bowls, and Chiram completed all the works he made for King Solomon in the house of the Lord:

27 two pillars and the twisted works of the pillars on the heads of the two pillars and two nets to cover both twisted works of the carvings which were upon the pillars,

28 four hundred pomegranates for both nets, two rows of pomegranates for one net to cover both twisted works upon both pillars,

29 and the ten mechonoth and the ten chytrokauloi upon the mechonoth,

30 and the one sea and the twelve oxen beneath the sea,

31 and the cauldrons and the heating vessels and the bowls and all the vessels that Chiram made for King Solomon for the house of the Lord; and the forty-eight pillars of the king's house and the house of the Lord. All the king's works that Chiram made were bronze throughout.

32 There was no weight for the bronze from which he made all these works because of its great quantity; there was no limit to the weight of the bronze.

33 In the region around the Jordan the king cast them in the thickness of the earth between Sokchoth and Sira.

34 And King Solomon placed the vessels which he made in the house of the Lord: the golden altar and the golden table upon which were the loaves of the offering,

35 and the lampstands, five on the right and five on the left before the dabir, of enclosed gold, and the lamps and the lights and the golden ladles,

36 and the entrances and the nails and the bowls and the dishes and the golden incense vessels, enclosed, and the doorways of the doors of the innermost house, the holy of holies, and the doors of the house of the temple, golden.

37 And all the work which Solomon made for the house of the Lord was completed, and Solomon brought in the holy things of David his father and all the holy things of Solomon, the silver and the gold and the vessels, and placed them in the treasuries of the house of the Lord.

38 And Solomon built his own house in thirteen years.

39 And he built the house of the forest of Lebanon; its length was a hundred cubits and its width fifty cubits and its height thirty cubits; and there were three rows of cedar pillars and cedar shoulders for the pillars.

40 And he paneled the house above upon the sides of the pillars, and the number of the pillars was forty-five, fifteen to a row.

41 And there were three beams and space upon space threefold.

42 And all the doorways and spaces were square and beamed, and from doorway to door threefold.

43 And the aelam of the pillars was fifty cubits long and thirty wide, joined, an aelam before them, and pillars and thickness before it for the aelamim.

44 And the aelam of the thrones, where he would judge there, was an aelam of judgment.

45 And there was a house for him in which he would sit, one courtyard extending for them according to this work; and a house for Pharaoh's daughter, whom Solomon took, according to this aelam.

46 All these were of precious stones carved to a measured spacing inside, from the foundation as far as the cornices, and outside to the great courtyard,

47 which was founded upon great precious stones, ten-cubit stones and eight-cubit stones,

48 and above with precious hewn stones according to the measure and with cedars.

49 Around the great courtyard were three courses of hewn stones and a course of carved cedar.

50 And Solomon completed all his house.

Chapter 8

1 And when Solomon finished building the house of the Lord and his own house after twenty years, then King Solomon assembled all the elders of Israel in Sion to bring up the ark of the covenant of the Lord from the city of David [this is Sion]

2 in the month Athanin.

3 And the priests lifted the ark

4 and the tent of testimony and all the holy vessels that were in the tent of testimony,

5 and the king and all Israel before the ark sacrificed sheep and oxen beyond number.

6 And the priests brought the ark into its place, into the dabir of the house, into the holy of holies, beneath the wings of the cherubim.

7 For the cherubim spread their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its holy things from above,

8 and the consecrated things projected, and the heads of the consecrated things could be seen from the holy place before the dabir, but they were not seen outside.

9 There was nothing in the ark except two stone tablets, tablets of the covenant, which Moses placed there in Choreb, which the Lord made with the sons of Israel when they went out from the land of Egypt.

10 And it happened when the priests went out of the holy place that the cloud filled the house.

11 And the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud, for the glory of the Lord filled the house.

14 And the king turned his face and blessed all Israel, and all the assembly of Israel stood.

15 And he said, Blessed is the Lord God of Israel today, who spoke by his mouth concerning David my father and by his hands fulfilled it, saying,

16 From the day I brought my people Israel out of Egypt I did not choose a city in any one scepter of Israel to build a house for my name to be there; and I chose Jerusalem for my name to be there and chose David to be over my people Israel.

17 And it was upon the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the Lord God of Israel.

18 And the Lord said to David my father, Because it came upon your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it came upon your heart;

19 but you shall not build the house, rather your son who comes out of your sides, he shall build the house for my name.

20 And the Lord established his word that he spoke, and I arose instead of David my father and sat upon the throne of Israel, as the Lord spoke, and built the house for the name of the Lord God of Israel.

21 And I placed there a place for the ark, in which is the covenant of the Lord there, which the Lord made with our fathers when he brought them out from the land of Egypt.

22 And Solomon stood before the altar of the Lord in the presence of all the assembly of Israel and spread out his hands toward heaven

23 and said, Lord God of Israel, there is no god like you in heaven above and on earth below, keeping covenant and mercy for your servant who walks before you with all his heart,

24 which you kept for your servant David my father, and you spoke with your mouth and fulfilled with your hands, as on this day.

25 And now, Lord God of Israel, keep for your servant David my father what you spoke to him, saying, A man of yours shall not be taken from before me, sitting on the throne of Israel, if only your children keep their ways to walk before me, as you walked before me.

26 And now, Lord God of Israel, let your word to David my father be confirmed.

27 For will God truly dwell with men upon the earth? If heaven and the heaven of heaven will not suffice for you, how much less this house which I built for your name?

28 And look upon my supplication, Lord God of Israel, to hear the delight with which your servant prays before you to you today,

29 that your eyes may be open toward this house day and night, toward the place of which you said, My name shall be there, to hear the prayer which your servant prays toward this place day and night.

30 And hear the supplication of your servant and of your people Israel when they pray toward this place; and you shall hear in the place of your dwelling in heaven and act and be merciful.

31 Whenever a person sins against his neighbor and a curse is laid upon him to make him swear, and he comes and confesses before your altar in this house,

32 then hear from heaven and act and judge your people Israel, to condemn the lawless one by giving his way upon his head and to justify the righteous one by giving to him according to his righteousness.

33 When your people Israel stumble before enemies because they sin against you, and they turn back and confess your name and pray and supplicate in this house,

34 then hear from heaven and be merciful to the sins of your people Israel and bring them back to the land which you gave to their fathers.

35 When heaven is restrained and there is no rain because they sin against you, and they pray toward this place and confess your name and turn back from their sins when you humble them,

36 then hear from heaven and be merciful to the sins of your servant and your people Israel, for you shall show them the good way to walk in it, and give rain upon the land which you gave your people as an inheritance.

37 If famine occurs, if death occurs, if there is burning, a locust, if rust occurs, and if their enemy afflicts them in one of their cities, any occurrence, any pain,

38 any prayer, any supplication, if it occurs to any man, as each knows the touch of his heart and spreads out his hands toward this house,

39 then hear from heaven, from your ready dwelling place, and be merciful and act and give to a man according to his ways, as you know his heart, for you alone know the heart of all sons of men,

40 so that they may fear you all the days they live upon the land which you gave to our fathers.

41 And for the foreigner who is not of your people,

42 when they come and pray toward this place,

43 then hear from heaven, from your ready dwelling place, and do according to all that the foreigner calls upon you for, so that all the peoples of the earth may know your name and fear you as your people Israel do and know that your name has been called over this house which I built.

44 For when your people go out to war against their enemies in the way in which you turn them, and pray in the name of the Lord toward the city which I chose in it and the house which I built for your name,

45 then hear from heaven their supplication and their prayer and do justice for them.

46 For they will sin against you, for there is no man who will not sin, and you will bring against them and hand them over before enemies, and those taking them captive will carry them captive to a land far or near,

47 and they will turn their hearts in the land to which they were taken, and turn back and supplicate you in the land of their exile, saying, We have sinned, acted lawlessly, done wrong,

48 and turn back to you with all their heart and all their soul in the land of their enemies to which you brought them, and pray to you toward their land which you gave their fathers, the city which I chose, and the house which I built for your name,

49 then hear from heaven, from your ready dwelling place,

50 and be merciful to their wrongdoings by which they sinned against you, and to all their transgressions by which they transgressed against you, and give them compassion before those holding them captive, and they shall have compassion on them.

51 For they are your people and your inheritance, whom you brought out from the land of Egypt, from the midst of an iron furnace.

52 And let your eyes and your ears be open to the supplication of your servant and to the supplication of your people Israel, to hear them in everything for which they call upon you,

53 for you set them apart for yourself as an inheritance from all the peoples of the earth, as you spoke by the hand of your servant Moses when you brought our fathers out from the land of Egypt, Lord, Lord.

53 Then Solomon spoke about the house when he finished building it: The Lord made the sun known in heaven; he said to dwell in gloom. Build my house, a splendid house for yourself, to dwell in newness. Is this not written in the book of song?

54 And it happened when Solomon finished praying to the Lord all this prayer and supplication, that he arose from before the altar of the Lord, having knelt upon his knees with his hands spread toward heaven.

55 And he stood and blessed all the assembly of Israel with a great voice, saying,

56 Blessed is the Lord today, who gave rest to his people Israel according to all he spoke; not one word failed of all his good words which he spoke by the hand of Moses his servant.

57 May the Lord our God be with us as he was with our fathers; may he neither abandon us nor turn us away,

58 to incline our hearts to him, to walk in all his ways and keep all his commandments and his ordinances which he commanded our fathers.

59 And may these words with which I made supplication before the Lord our God be near to the Lord our God day and night, to do justice for your servant and justice for your people Israel, each day's matter in its day,

60 so that all the peoples of the earth may know that the Lord is God, he is God and there is no other.

61 And let our hearts be complete toward the Lord our God and walk holily in his ordinances and keep his commandments, as on this day.

62 And the king and all the sons of Israel sacrificed a sacrifice before the Lord.

63 And King Solomon sacrificed the sacrifices of peace offerings that he sacrificed to the Lord, twenty-two thousand oxen and one hundred twenty thousand sheep; and the king and all the sons of Israel dedicated the house of the Lord.

64 On that day the king consecrated the middle of the courtyard before the house of the Lord, for there he made the whole burnt offering and the sacrifices and the fats of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar before the Lord was too small to bear the whole burnt offering and the sacrifices of the peace offerings.

65 And Solomon held the feast on that day, and all Israel with him, a great assembly from the entrance of Emath as far as the river of Egypt, before the Lord our God in the house he built, eating and drinking and rejoicing before the Lord our God for seven days.

66 And on the eighth day he sent the people away and blessed them, and each went to his tent rejoicing and with a good heart over the good things which the Lord had done for David his servant and for Israel his people.

Chapter 9

1 And it happened when Solomon finished building the house of the Lord and the king's house and all Solomon's work which he wished to do,

2 that the Lord appeared to Solomon a second time, as he had appeared in Gabaon.

3 And the Lord said to him, I have heard the voice of your prayer and your supplication which you made before me; I have done for you according to all your prayer, I have consecrated this house which you built, to set my name there forever, and my eyes and my heart shall be there all the days.

4 And you, if you walk before me as David your father walked, in holiness of heart and in uprightness and doing according to all I commanded him, and keep my ordinances and my commandments,

5 then I shall establish the throne of your kingdom over Israel forever, as I spoke to David your father, saying, A man of yours leading in Israel shall not be taken away.

6 But if you and your children turn away from me and do not keep my commandments and my ordinances which Moses gave before you, and go and serve other gods and bow to them,

7 then I shall remove Israel from the land which I gave them, and this house which I consecrated for my name I shall cast away from my face, and Israel shall become a disappearance and a byword among all peoples.

8 And this high house, everyone passing through it shall be astonished and whistle and say, Why has the Lord done thus to this land and this house?

9 And they shall say, Because they abandoned the Lord their God who brought their fathers out of Egypt, out of a house of bondage, and took hold of foreign gods and bowed to them and served them; therefore the Lord brought this evil upon them.

9 Then Solomon brought Pharaoh's daughter up from the city of David into his house which he built for himself in those days.

10 Twenty years in which Solomon built the two houses, the house of the Lord and the king's house,

11 Chiram king of Tyre supported Solomon with cedar wood and pine wood and gold and all his desire. Then the king gave Chiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee.

12 And Chiram went out from Tyre and went to Galilee to see the cities Solomon gave him, and they did not please him.

13 And he said, What are these cities that you gave me, brother? And he called them Border to this day.

14 And Chiram brought Solomon a hundred and twenty talents of gold,

26 and a ship for which King Solomon made in Gasiongaber, which is beside Ailath on the shore of the farthest sea in the land of Edom.

27 And Chiram sent in the ship of his servants seafaring men who knew how to sail the sea with Solomon's servants.

28 And they came to Sophera and took from there a hundred and twenty talents of gold and brought them to King Solomon.

Chapter 10

1 And the queen of Saba heard the name of Solomon and the name of the Lord and came to test him with riddles.

2 And she came to Jerusalem with a very heavy force, and camels carrying spices and very much gold and precious stone, and she went in to Solomon and spoke to him all that was in her heart.

3 And Solomon told her all her words; there was no word overlooked by the king that he did not tell her.

4 And the queen of Saba saw all Solomon's understanding and the house which he built,

5 and Solomon's food and the seating of his servants and the standing of his ministers and his clothing and his cupbearers and his whole burnt offering which he offered in the house of the Lord, and she became beside herself.

6 And she said to King Solomon, The word I heard in my land about your word and your understanding was true,

7 and I did not believe those who spoke to me until I came and my eyes saw; and behold, there is not half as much as they told me, you have added good things to it beyond all the report I heard in my land.

8 Blessed are your women, blessed are these servants of yours who stand before you continually and hear all your understanding.

9 May the Lord your God be blessed, who took pleasure in you to place you upon the throne of Israel; because the Lord loves Israel to establish it forever, he placed you as king over them to do judgment in righteousness and in their judgments.

10 And she gave Solomon a hundred and twenty talents of gold and very many spices and precious stone; spices like those had not yet come in such quantity as the queen of Saba gave King Solomon.

11 [And Chiram's ship that carried gold from Souphir brought very much hewn wood and precious stone.

12 And the king made the hewn wood into supports for the house of the Lord and the king's house, and harps and lyres for the singers; such hewn wood had not come upon the earth nor been seen anywhere until this day.]

13 And King Solomon gave the queen of Saba all she desired, all she asked, besides all that he had given her by the hand of King Solomon; and she turned and went to her land, she and all her servants.

14 And the weight of gold that came to Solomon in one year was six hundred and sixty-six talents of gold,

15 apart from the levies of the subjects and of the merchants and of all the kings of the region beyond and the satraps of the land.

16 And Solomon made three hundred beaten golden spears; three hundred pieces of gold were upon each spear.

17 And three hundred beaten golden arms; three minas of gold were in each arm; and he placed them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.

18 And the king made a great ivory throne and overlaid it with refined gold.

19 There were six steps to the throne, and heads of calves for the throne at its back, and arms on either side at the seat, and two lions standing beside the arms,

20 and twelve lions standing upon the six steps on either side; nothing like it existed in any kingdom.

21 And all Solomon's drinking vessels were gold and the basins were gold, all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon enclosed with gold; there was no silver, for it was not reckoned in Solomon's days.

22 For the king had a ship of Tharsis at sea with Chiram's ships; once in three years a ship came to the king from Tharsis with gold and silver and carved and hewn stones.

22 This was the work of the levy which King Solomon raised to build the house of the Lord and the king's house and the wall of Jerusalem and the citadel, to enclose the enclosure of the city of David, and Assour and Magdan and Gazer and upper Baithoron and Jethermath and all the chariot cities and all the horsemen's cities and the work of Solomon which he undertook to build in Jerusalem and in all the land, so as not to begin it.

23 All the people remaining of the Chettite and the Amorite and the Pherezite and the Chananite and the Evaite and the Jebusite and the Gergesaite, who were not of the sons of Israel, their children remaining after them in the land, whom the sons of Israel were not able to destroy, Solomon raised them for tribute until this day.

24 And Solomon did not assign the sons of Israel to work, for they were the men who were warriors and his servants and commanders of his chariots and his horsemen.

23 And Solomon became greater than all the kings of the earth in riches and understanding.

24 And all the kings of the earth sought Solomon's face to hear his understanding which the Lord placed in his heart.

25 And each brought his gifts, golden vessels and clothing, stacte and spices and horses and mules, year by year.

26 And Solomon had four thousand female horses for chariots and twelve thousand horsemen, and he placed them in the chariot cities and with the king in Jerusalem.

26 And he was ruler of all the kings from the river to the land of the foreigners and to the borders of Egypt.

27 And the king made gold and silver in Jerusalem like stones, and cedars he made as numerous as the sycamores in the plain.

28 And the export of Solomon's horses was from Egypt and from Thekoue; the king's merchants acquired them from Thekoue in exchange.

29 And the export came up from Egypt, a chariot for a hundred pieces of silver and a horse for fifty pieces of silver; and thus they went out by sea to all the kings of the Chettiim and the kings of Syria.

Chapter 11

1 And King Solomon was a lover of women. And he had seven hundred ruling women and three hundred concubines. And he took foreign women and Pharaoh's daughter, Moabite women, Ammanite women, Syrian and Idumaean women, Chettite and Amorite women,

2 from the nations about which the Lord had forbidden the sons of Israel: You shall not go in to them, and they shall not go in to you, lest they turn your hearts after their idols. To these Solomon clung in love.

4 And it happened in the time of Solomon's old age that his heart was not complete with the Lord his God as the heart of David his father was, and the foreign women turned his heart after their gods.

5 Then Solomon built a high place for Chamos, an idol of Moab, and for their king, an idol of the sons of Ammon,

6 and for Astarte, an abomination of the Sidonians.

7 And thus he did for all his foreign women, burning incense and sacrificing to their idols.

8 And Solomon did evil before the Lord; he did not walk after the Lord as David his father did.

9 And the Lord was angry with Solomon because he turned his heart away from the Lord God of Israel who had appeared to him twice

10 and had commanded him concerning this matter not at all to go after other gods, and to take care to do what the Lord God commanded him.

11 And the Lord said to Solomon, Because these things happened with you and you did not keep my commandments and my ordinances which I commanded you, I shall surely tear your kingdom from your hand and give it to your servant.

12 But in your days I shall not do it for the sake of David your father; from the hand of your son I shall take it.

13 Yet I shall certainly not take the whole kingdom; I shall give one scepter to your son for the sake of David my servant and Jerusalem, the city which I chose.

14 And the Lord raised up a satan for Solomon, Ader the Idumaean, and Esrom son of Eliadae who was in Raemmath under Adrazar king of Souba, his lord; and men gathered to him, and he was leader of a band and seized Damascus beforehand; and they were satans to Israel all the days of Solomon. And Ader the Idumaean was of the royal seed in Idumaea.

15 And it happened when David destroyed Edom, when Joab the commander of the army went to bury the wounded, they cut down every male in Idumaea,

16 for Joab and all Israel stayed there six months in Idumaea, until he destroyed every male from Idumaea.

17 And Ader fled, he and all the Idumaean men among his father's servants with him, and they entered Egypt; and Ader was a small boy.

18 And men arose from the city of Madiam and came to Pharan and took men with them and came to Pharaoh king of Egypt; and Ader went in to Pharaoh, and he gave him a house and appointed bread for him.

19 And Ader found very great favor before Pharaoh, and he gave him as wife his wife's sister, the sister of the elder Thekemina.

20 And Thekemina's sister bore to Ader her son Ganebath, and Thekemina brought him up among Pharaoh's sons, and Ganebath was among Pharaoh's sons.

21 And Ader heard in Egypt that David had lain down with his fathers and that Joab the commander of the army had died; and Ader said to Pharaoh, Send me away, and I shall return to my land.

22 And Pharaoh said to Ader, In what are you lacking with me? And behold, you seek to depart to your land. And Ader said to him, But you shall surely send me away. And Ader returned to his land.

25 This was the evil which Ader did; and he was heavy in spirit in Israel and reigned in the land of Edom.

26 And Jeroboam son of Nabat, the Ephrathite from Sarira, son of a widowed woman, a servant of Solomon,

27 and this was the matter when he raised hands against King Solomon: he built the citadel and closed the enclosure of the city of David his father.

28 And the man Jeroboam was mighty in strength, and Solomon saw that the young man was a man of works, and appointed him over the burdens of the house of Joseph.

29 And it happened at that time that Jeroboam went out from Jerusalem, and Achias the Selonite prophet found him on the road and led him aside from the road; and Achias was clothed in a new garment, and both were in the plain.

30 And Achia took hold of his new garment upon him and tore it into twelve tears

31 and said to Jeroboam, Take ten tears for yourself, for thus says the Lord God of Israel: Behold, I tear the kingdom from the hand of Solomon and shall give you ten scepters,

32 and two scepters shall be his for the sake of David my servant and Jerusalem the city which I chose in it from all the tribes of Israel,

33 because he abandoned me and acted for Astarte, the abomination of the Sidonians, and for Chamos and the idols of Moab and their king, the abhorrence of the sons of Ammon, and did not walk in my ways to do what is right before me as David his father did.

34 And I shall certainly not take the whole kingdom from his hand, because I shall surely stand against him all the days of his life, for the sake of David my servant whom I chose.

35 And I shall take the kingdom from the hand of his son and give you the ten scepters,

36 but to his son I shall give the two scepters, so that there may be a place for my servant David all the days before me in Jerusalem, the city which I chose for myself to place my name there.

37 And I shall take you, and you shall reign over what your soul desires, and you shall be king over Israel.

38 And it shall be, if you keep all that I command you and walk in my ways and do what is right before me, taking care to keep my commandments and my ordinances as David my servant did, then I shall be with you and build you a faithful house, as I built for David.

40 And Solomon sought to put Jeroboam to death, and he arose and fled to Egypt to Sousakim king of Egypt and was in Egypt until Solomon died.

41 And the rest of Solomon's words and all that he did and all his understanding, are they not written in the book of Solomon's words?

42 And the days Solomon reigned in Jerusalem were forty years.

43 And Solomon lay down with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David his father. And it happened when Jeroboam son of Nabat heard, while he was still in Egypt, having fled from before Solomon and dwelt in Egypt, he made his way and came to his city in the land of Sarira in the hill country of Ephraim. And King Solomon lay down with his fathers, and Roboam his son reigned instead of him.

Chapter 12

1 And King Roboam went to Sikima, for all Israel came to Sikima to make him king.

3 And the people spoke to King Roboam, saying,

4 Your father made our yoke heavy; now you lighten the hard service of your father and his heavy yoke which he placed upon us, and we shall serve you.

5 And he said to them, Go away for three days and return to me; and they went away.

6 And the king gave notice to the elders who had stood before Solomon his father while he was still alive, saying, How do you advise that I answer this people with a word?

7 And they spoke to him, saying, If today you become a servant to this people and serve them and speak good words to them, they will be your servants all the days.

8 And he abandoned the counsel of the elders which they had given him and consulted the young men who had grown up with him and stood before him.

9 And he said to them, What do you advise, and what shall I answer this people who spoke to me, saying, Lighten the yoke that your father placed upon us?

10 And the young men who had grown up with him and stood before him spoke to him, saying, Thus you shall speak to this people who spoke to you, saying, Your father made our yoke heavy, and now you lighten it from us; thus you shall speak to them: My little part is thicker than my father's waist.

11 And now my father loaded you with a heavy yoke, and I shall add to your yoke; my father disciplined you with whips, but I shall discipline you with scorpions.

12 And all Israel came to King Roboam on the third day, as the king had spoken to them, saying, Return to me on the third day.

13 And the king answered the people harshly, and Roboam abandoned the counsel of the elders which they had given him.

14 And he spoke to them according to the counsel of the young men, saying, My father made your yoke heavy, and I shall add to your yoke; my father disciplined you with whips, and I shall discipline you with scorpions.

15 And the king did not listen to the people, for a turning was from the Lord so that he might establish his word which he spoke by the hand of Achia the Selonite concerning Jeroboam son of Nabat.

16 And all Israel saw that their king did not listen to them, and the people answered the king, saying, What share have we in David? And we have no inheritance in the son of Jessai. Go away, Israel, to your tents. Now tend your house, David. And Israel went away to its tents.

18 And the king sent Adoniram, the one over the tribute, and all Israel stoned him with stones, and he died; and King Roboam managed to go up to flee to Jerusalem.

19 And Israel rejected the house of David until this day.

20 And it happened when all Israel heard that Jeroboam had returned from Egypt that they sent and called him to the assembly and made him king over Israel; and there was none following the house of David except the scepter of Judah and Benjamin alone.

21 And Roboam came into Jerusalem and assembled the congregation of Judah and the scepter of Benjamin, a hundred and twenty thousand young men who made war, to fight against the house of Israel to return the kingdom to Roboam son of Solomon.

22 And the word of the Lord came to Samaia the man of God, saying,

23 Say to Roboam son of Solomon, king of Judah, and to all the house of Judah and Benjamin and the remainder of the people, saying,

24 Thus says the Lord: You shall not go up nor fight with your brothers, the sons of Israel. Let each return to his own house, for this matter has come from me. And they heard the word of the Lord and stopped going, according to the word of the Lord.

24 And King Solomon lay down with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David. And Roboam his son reigned instead of him in Jerusalem, being a son of sixteen years when he began to reign, and he reigned twelve years in Jerusalem, and the name of his mother was Naanan daughter of Anan son of Naas king of the sons of Ammon; and he did evil before the Lord and did not walk in the way of David his father.

25 And there was a man from the hill country of Ephraim, a servant of Solomon, and his name was Jeroboam, and his mother's name was Sarira, a prostitute; and Solomon made him a commander of the staff over the burdens of the house of Joseph, and he built Sarira in the hill country of Ephraim for Solomon, and he had chariots of three hundred horses; he built the citadel among the burdens of the house of Ephraim, he closed the city of David, and he was exalting himself toward the kingdom.

26 And Solomon sought to put him to death, and he feared and fled to Sousakim king of Egypt and was with him until Solomon died.

27 And Jeroboam heard in Egypt that Solomon had died, and spoke into the ears of Sousakim king of Egypt, saying, Send me away and I shall go to my land. And Sousakim said to him, Ask some request and I shall give it to you.

28 And Sousakim gave Jeroboam Ano, sister of Thekemina, the elder of his wife, as wife; she was great among the king's daughters and bore Jeroboam his son Abia.

29 And Jeroboam said to Sousakim, Indeed send me away, and I shall go. And Jeroboam went out from Egypt and came to the land of Sarira in the hill country of Ephraim; and all the scepter of Ephraim gathered there; and Jeroboam built a palisade there.

30 And his young child became sick with a very severe sickness; and Jeroboam went to inquire about the child; and he said to Ano his wife, Arise and go, inquire of God about the child, whether he will live from his sickness.

31 And there was a man in Selo, and his name was Achia, and he was a son of sixty years, and the word of the Lord was with him. And Jeroboam said to his wife, Arise and take in your hand for the man of God loaves and small cakes for his children and a cluster of grapes and a jar of honey.

32 And the woman arose and took in her hand loaves and two small cakes and a cluster of grapes and a jar of honey for Achia; and the man was old, and his eyes were dim for seeing.

24 And she arose from Sarira and went, and it happened as she entered the city toward Achia the Selonite that Achia said to his young servant, Go out now to meet Ano the wife of Jeroboam and say to her, Come in and do not stand still, for thus says the Lord: I shall send harsh things upon you.

25 And Ano went in to the man of God, and Achia said to her, Why have you brought me loaves and a cluster of grapes and small cakes and a jar of honey? Thus says the Lord: Behold, you shall depart from me, and when you enter the gate into Sarira your girls shall come out to meet you and say to you, The child has died.

26 For thus says the Lord: Behold, I shall destroy of Jeroboam one who urinates against a wall, and the dogs shall eat those of Jeroboam who die in the city, and the birds of heaven shall eat the one who dies in the field. And they shall lament the child, Alas, lord, for a good word concerning the Lord was found in him.

27 And the woman went away as she heard, and it happened as she entered Sarira that the child died, and the cry came out to meet her.

28 And Jeroboam went to Sikima in the hill country of Ephraim and gathered the tribes of Israel there, and Roboam son of Solomon went up there. And the word of the Lord came to Samaia the Elamite, saying, Take for yourself a new garment that has not gone into water and tear it into twelve tears and give it to Jeroboam and say to him, Thus says the Lord: Take for yourself ten tears to put around yourself. And Jeroboam took them; and Samaia said, Thus says the Lord concerning the ten tribes of Israel.

29 And the people said to Roboam son of Solomon, Your father made his yoke heavy upon us and made the food of his table heavy; and now if you lighten it upon us, we shall serve you. And Roboam said to the people, In three more days I shall answer you with a word.

30 And Roboam said, Bring the elders in to me, and I shall consult with them about what word I shall answer the people on the third day. And Roboam spoke into their ears as the people had sent to him, and the elders of the people said, Thus the people spoke to you.

25 And Roboam scattered their counsel, and it did not please him; and he sent and brought in his companions and spoke the same things to them: And these things the people sent to me, saying. And his companions said, Thus you shall speak to the people, saying, My little part is thicker than my father's waist; my father whipped you with whips, but I shall rule over you with scorpions.

26 And the word pleased Roboam, and he answered the people as his companions, the young men, had counseled him.

27 And all the people said as one man, each to his neighbor, and all cried out, saying, We have no share in David nor inheritance in the son of Jessai; to your tents, Israel, for this man is neither a ruler nor a leader.

28 And all the people scattered from Sikima, and each went to his tent. And Roboam prevailed and went away and mounted his chariot and entered Jerusalem, and all the scepter of Judah and all the scepter of Benjamin went after him.

24 And it happened at the turn of the year that Roboam gathered every man of Judah and Benjamin and went up to fight against Jeroboam in Sikima.

25 And the word of the Lord came to Samaia the man of God, saying, Say to Roboam king of Judah and to all the house of Judah and Benjamin and to the remnant of the people, saying, Thus says the Lord: You shall not go up nor fight against your brothers, the sons of Israel. Return each to his house, for this matter has come from me.

26 And they heard the word of the Lord and refrained from going, according to the word of the Lord.

25 And Jeroboam built Sikima in the hill country of Ephraim and lived in it; and he went out from there and built Phanouel.

26 And Jeroboam said in his heart, Behold, now the kingdom shall return to the house of David.

27 If this people goes up to offer sacrifices in the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, then the heart of the people will turn to the Lord and to their lord, Roboam king of Judah, and they will kill me.

28 And the king took counsel and went and made two golden heifers and said to the people, Let it suffice for you to go up to Jerusalem. Behold your gods, Israel, who brought you up from the land of Egypt.

29 And he placed one in Bethel and one he placed in Dan.

30 And this matter became a sin; and the people went before the one as far as Dan.

31 And he made houses on high places and made priests, a certain portion from the people, who were not of the sons of Levi.

32 And Jeroboam made a feast in the eighth month on the fifteenth day of the month like the feast in the land of Judah, and went up on the altar which he made in Bethel to sacrifice to the heifers which he made, and stationed in Bethel the priests of the high places which he made.

33 And he went up on the altar which he made on the fifteenth day in the eighth month, at the feast which he devised from his heart, and made a feast for the sons of Israel and went up on the altar to burn sacrifice.

Chapter 13

1 And behold, a man of God from Judah came by the word of the Lord to Bethel, and Jeroboam stood at the altar to burn sacrifice.

2 And he called out to the altar by the word of the Lord and said, Altar, altar, thus says the Lord: Behold, a son is born to the house of David; his name is Josias, and he shall sacrifice upon you the priests of the high places who burn sacrifice upon you, and shall burn human bones upon you.

3 And he gave a sign on that day, saying, This is the word that the Lord spoke, saying, Behold, the altar is torn apart, and the fatness upon it shall be poured out.

4 And it happened when King Jeroboam heard the words of the man of God who called out against the altar in Bethel that the king stretched out his hand from the altar, saying, Seize him; and behold, the hand he stretched toward him withered, and he could not draw it back to himself.

5 And the altar was torn apart, and the fatness was poured out from the altar according to the sign which the man of God gave by the word of the Lord.

6 And King Jeroboam said to the man of God, Entreat the face of the Lord your God, and let my hand return to me. And the man of God entreated the face of the Lord, and he restored the king's hand to him, and it became as before.

7 And the king spoke to the man of God, Come in with me to the house and eat a meal, and I shall give you a gift.

8 And the man of God said to the king, If you give me half your house, I shall not go in with you nor eat bread nor drink water in this place.

9 For thus the Lord commanded me by word, saying, Do not eat bread and do not drink water and do not return by the way in which you went.

10 And he went away by another way and did not return by the way in which he came to Bethel.

11 And one old prophet dwelt in Bethel, and his sons came and related to him all the deeds that the man of God did that day in Bethel and the words he spoke to the king; and they turned to the face of their father.

12 And their father spoke to them, saying, By which way has he gone? And his sons showed him the way by which the man of God who came from Judah went up.

13 And he said to his sons, Saddle the donkey for me; and they saddled the donkey for him, and he mounted it.

14 And he went after the man of God and found him sitting under an oak and said to him, Are you the man of God who has come from Judah? And he said to him, I am.

15 And he said to him, Come with me and eat bread.

16 And he said, I shall certainly not be able to return with you, nor shall I eat bread or drink water in this place.

17 For thus the Lord has commanded me by word, saying, Do not eat bread there and do not drink water there and do not return by the way in which you went.

18 And he said to him, I too am a prophet as you are, and an angel has spoken to me by the word of the Lord, saying, Bring him back with you to your house, and let him eat bread and drink water. And he lied to him.

19 And he brought him back, and he ate bread and drank water in his house.

20 And it happened while they sat at the table that the word of the Lord came to the prophet who brought him back,

21 and he said to the man of God who came from Judah, saying, Thus says the Lord: Because you provoked the word of the Lord and did not keep the commandment which the Lord your God commanded you,

22 and you returned and ate bread and drank water in this place of which he spoke to you, saying, Do not eat bread and do not drink water, your body shall certainly not enter the tomb of your fathers.

23 And it happened after eating bread and drinking water that he saddled the donkey for him, and he returned.

24 And he went away, and a lion found him on the road and put him to death, and his body was cast upon the road, and the donkey stood beside it, and the lion stood beside the body.

25 And behold, men passing by saw the corpse cast upon the road, and the lion stood beside the corpse; and they came in and spoke in the city where the old prophet dwelt.

26 And the one who had brought him back from the road heard and said, This is the man of God who provoked the word of the Lord.

28 And he went and found his body cast upon the road, and the donkey and the lion stood beside the body, and the lion had not eaten the body of the man of God and had not torn the donkey.

29 And the prophet lifted the body of the man of God and placed it upon the donkey, and the prophet brought him back to the city to bury him

30 in his own tomb; and they lamented him, Alas, brother.

31 And it happened after he lamented him that he said to his sons, saying, When I die, bury me in this tomb in which the man of God is buried; place me beside his bones, so that my bones may be preserved with his bones.

32 For the word which he spoke by the word of the Lord against the altar in Bethel and against the houses of the high places in Samaria shall surely come to pass.

33 And after this word Jeroboam did not turn back from his evil, and he turned and made priests of the high places from a portion of the people; whoever wished, he filled his hand, and he became a priest for the high places.

34 And this matter became sin for the house of Jeroboam and ruin and disappearance from the face of the earth. ... 211 21 And Roboam son of Solomon reigned over Judah; Roboam was a son of forty-one years when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which the Lord chose to place his name there from all the tribes of Israel; and his mother's name was Naama the Ammanite.

Chapter 14

22 And Roboam did evil before the Lord and provoked him to jealousy in all that his fathers did and in their sins with which they sinned.

23 And they built for themselves high places and pillars and groves upon every high hill and beneath every shady tree.

24 And a bond came about in the land, and they did some of all the abominations of the nations which the Lord removed from before the sons of Israel.

25 And it happened in the fifth year of Roboam's reign that Sousakim king of Egypt went up against Jerusalem

26 and took all the treasures of the house of the Lord and the treasures of the king's house and the golden spears which David had taken from the hand of the servants of Adraazar king of Souba and brought into Jerusalem; he took everything, the golden arms.

27 And King Roboam made bronze arms instead of them. And the leaders of the runners who guarded the entrance of the king's house placed them upon him.

28 And it happened when the king entered the house of the Lord that the runners carried them and leaned them in the thee of the runners.

29 And the rest of the words of Roboam and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days for the kings of Judah?

30 And there was war between Roboam and Jeroboam all the days.

31 And Roboam lay down with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Abiou his son reigned instead of him.

Chapter 15

1 And in the eighteenth year of the reign of Jeroboam son of Nabat, Abiou son of Roboam reigned over Judah,

2 and he reigned six years, and his mother's name was Maacha daughter of Abessalom.

3 And he walked in the sins of his father which he did before him, and his heart was not complete with the Lord his God as the heart of David his father was.

4 For David's sake the Lord gave him a remnant, to establish his children after him and establish Jerusalem,

5 as David did what was right before the Lord and did not turn aside from all that he commanded him all the days of his life.

7 And the rest of Abiou's words and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days for the kings of Judah? And there was war between Abiou and Jeroboam.

8 And Abiou lay down with his fathers in the twenty-fourth year of Jeroboam and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Asa his son reigned instead of him.

9 In the twenty-fourth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa reigned over Judah,

10 and he reigned forty-one years in Jerusalem, and his mother's name was Ana daughter of Abessalom.

11 And Asa did what was right before the Lord as David his father did.

12 And he removed the rites from the land and sent away all the practices that his fathers had made.

13 And he removed Ana his mother from being leader, as she had made an assembly in her grove, and Asa cut down her descents and burned them with fire in the brook Kedron.

14 But he did not remove the high places; nevertheless Asa's heart was complete with the Lord all his days.

15 And he brought in the pillars of his father and his own pillars into the house of the Lord, silver and gold and vessels.

16 And there was war between Asa and Baasa king of Israel all the days.

17 And Baasa king of Israel went up against Judah and built Rama so that no one might go out or come in for Asa king of Judah.

18 And Asa took the silver and gold found in the treasuries of the king's house and gave them into the hands of his servants, and King Asa sent them to the son of Ader son of Taberemman son of Azin king of Syria, who lived in Damascus, saying,

19 Make a covenant between me and you and between my father and your father; behold, I have sent you gifts of silver and gold; come, break your covenant with Baasa king of Israel, and he will go up away from me.

20 And the son of Ader listened to King Asa and sent the commanders of his forces against the cities of Israel and struck Ain and Dan and Abelmaa and all Chezrath as far as all the land of Nephthali.

21 And it happened when Baasa heard that he stopped building Rama and returned to Thersa.

22 And King Asa gave notice to all Judah at Ainakim, and they carried away the stones of Rama and its timbers with which Baasa had built, and King Asa built with them all the hill of Benjamin and the watchtower.

23 And the rest of Asa's words and all his power which he exercised, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days for the kings of Judah? But in the time of his old age he suffered in his feet.

24 And Asa lay down and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Josaphat his son reigned instead of him.

25 And Nadab son of Jeroboam reigned over Israel in the second year of Asa king of Judah and reigned over Israel two years.

26 And he did evil before the Lord and walked in his father's way and in his sins with which he caused Israel to sin.

27 And Baasa son of Achia besieged him against the house of Belaan and struck him in Gabathon of the foreigners, and Nadab and all Israel had besieged Gabathon.

28 And Baasa put him to death in the third year of Asa son of Abiou king of Judah and reigned.

29 And it happened when he reigned that he struck the house of Jeroboam and did not leave any breath of Jeroboam until he destroyed him according to the word of the Lord which he spoke by the hand of his servant Achia the Selonite

30 concerning the sins of Jeroboam by which he caused Israel to sin and his provocation by which he provoked the Lord God of Israel.

31 And the rest of Nadab's words and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days for the kings of Israel?

33 And in the third year of Asa king of Judah, Baasa son of Achia reigned over Israel in Thersa for twenty-four years.

34 And he did evil before the Lord and walked in the way of Jeroboam son of Nabat and in his sins by which he caused Israel to sin.

Chapter 16

1 And the word of the Lord came by the hand of Jou son of Anani to Baasa:

2 Because I raised you from the earth and made you leader over my people Israel, and you walked in the way of Jeroboam and caused my people Israel to sin, to provoke me with their vanities,

3 behold, I raise up after Baasa and after his house, and I shall make your house like the house of Jeroboam son of Nabat.

4 The dogs shall eat the one of Baasa who dies in the city, and the birds of heaven shall eat the one of his who dies in the plain.

5 And the rest of Baasa's words and all that he did and his acts of power, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

6 And Baasa lay down with his fathers and was buried in Thersa, and Ela his son reigned instead of him in the twentieth year of King Asa.

7 And by the hand of Jou son of Anani the Lord spoke against Baasa and his house for all the evil which he did before the Lord to provoke him with the works of his hands, to become like the house of Jeroboam, and because he struck him.

8 And Ela son of Baasa reigned over Israel two years in Thersa.

9 And Zambri, commander of half the cavalry, conspired against him, and he was in Thersa drinking himself drunk in the house of Osa the steward in Thersa.

10 And Zambri entered and struck him and put him to death and reigned instead of him.

11 And it happened when he reigned, when he sat on his throne, that he struck the whole house of Baasa

12 according to the word which the Lord spoke against the house of Baasa to Jou the prophet,

13 concerning all the sins of Baasa and Ela his son, by which he caused Israel to sin, to provoke the Lord God of Israel with their vanities.

14 And the rest of Ela's words and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

15 And Zambri reigned seven days in Thersa. And the camp of Israel was against Gabathon of the foreigners,

16 and the people in the camp heard them saying, Zambri has conspired and struck the king; and they made Ambri, the commander of the army, king over Israel on that day in the camp.

17 And Ambri and all Israel with him went up from Gabathon and besieged Thersa.

18 And it happened when Zambri saw that his city had been seized beforehand, he went into a chamber of the king's house and burned the king's house over himself with fire and died

19 for his sins which he committed by doing evil before the Lord, walking in the way of Jeroboam son of Nabat and in his sins by which he caused Israel to sin.

20 And the rest of Zambri's words and the plots which he plotted, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

21 Then the people of Israel divided; half the people followed Thamni son of Gonath to make him king, and half the people followed Ambri.

22 The people following Ambri overpowered the people following Thamni son of Gonath, and Thamni and Joram his brother died at that time, and Ambri reigned after Thamni.

23 In the thirty-first year of King Asa, Ambri reigned over Israel twelve years. In Thersa he reigned six years.

24 And Ambri acquired Mount Semeron from Semer, owner of the mountain, for two talents of silver and built upon the mountain and called the name of the mountain which he built Saemeron after the name of Semer, owner of the mountain.

25 And Ambri did evil before the Lord and acted more wickedly than all who were before him.

26 And he walked in every way of Jeroboam son of Nabat and in his sins by which he caused Israel to sin, to provoke the Lord God of Israel with their vanities.

27 And the rest of Ambri's words and all that he did and his power, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Israel?

28 And Ambri lay down with his fathers and was buried in Samaria, and Achaab his son reigned instead of him.

28 And in the eleventh year of Ambri, Josaphat son of Asa reigned, being thirty-five years old at his accession, and he reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem, and his mother's name was Gazouba daughter of Selei.

29 And he walked in the way of Asa his father and did not turn aside from it, doing what was right before the Lord; but they did not remove the high places, and they sacrificed on the high places and burned incense.

30 And what Josaphat arranged, and all the power which he exercised and those whom he fought, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days of the kings of Judah?

31 And the rest of the entanglements which they had undertaken in the days of Asa his father he removed from the land.

32 And there was no king in Syria, a nasib.

33 And King Josaphat made a ship for Tharsis to go to Sophir for gold; and it did not go, because the ship was broken in Gasiongaber.

34 Then the king of Israel said to Josaphat, I shall send your servants and my young servants in the ship; and Josaphat did not wish it.

29 And Josaphat lay down with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David, and Joram his son reigned instead of him. In the second year of Josaphat, Achaab son of Ambri reigned; he reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty-two years.

30 And Achaab did evil before the Lord; he acted more wickedly than all who were before him.

31 And it was not enough for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, and he took as wife Jezabel daughter of Jethebaal king of the Sidonians and went and served Baal and bowed to him.

32 And he set up an altar to Baal in the house of his abhorrent things, which he built in Samaria.

33 And Achaab made a grove, and Achaab added provocations to provoke his own soul to be destroyed; he did evil beyond all the kings of Israel who were before him.

34 In his days Achiel the Bethelite built Jericho; with Abiron his firstborn he laid its foundation and with Segoub his younger son he set up its doors, according to the word of the Lord which he spoke by the hand of Joshua son of Naue.

Chapter 17

1 And Eliou the prophet, the Thesbite from Thesbon of Galaad, said to Achaab, As the Lord God of the forces, the God of Israel, lives, before whom I stand, if there shall be dew and rain in these years except by the mouth of my word.

2 And the word of the Lord came to Eliou:

3 Go from here toward the east and hide by the brook Chorrath facing the Jordan.

4 And you shall drink water from the brook, and I shall command the ravens to feed you there.

5 And Eliou did according to the word of the Lord and dwelt by the brook Chorrath facing the Jordan.

6 And the ravens brought him bread in the morning and meat in the evening, and he drank water from the brook.

7 And it happened after days that the brook dried up, because there was no rain upon the land.

8 And the word of the Lord came to Eliou:

9 Arise and go to Sarepta of Sidonia; behold, I have commanded a widowed woman there to feed you.

10 And he arose and went to Sarepta to the entrance of the city, and behold, a widowed woman there was gathering wood. And Eliou called after her and said to her, Take a little water for me in a vessel, and I shall drink.

11 And she went to take it, and Eliou called after her and said, Take a piece of bread for me in your hand.

12 And the woman said, As the Lord your God lives, if I have a cake, but only about a handful of flour in the jar and a little oil in the flask; and behold, I am gathering two little sticks, and I shall go in and make it for myself and my children, and we shall eat and die.

13 And Eliou said to her, Take courage, go in and do according to your word; but first make for me a small cake from it and bring it out to me, and afterward you shall make some for yourself and your children.

14 For thus says the Lord: The jar of flour shall not fail and the flask of oil shall not diminish until the day the Lord gives rain upon the land.

15 And the woman went and did it; and she and he and her children ate.

16 And the jar of flour did not fail and the flask of oil did not diminish according to the word of the Lord which he spoke by the hand of Eliou.

17 And it happened after these things that the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, became sick, and his sickness was very severe until no breath was left in him.

18 And she said to Eliou, What is there between me and you, man of God? Have you come to me to recall my wrongdoings and put my son to death?

19 And Eliou said to the woman, Give me your son. And he took him from her bosom and brought him up to the upper room in which he dwelt and laid him on his bed.

20 And Eliou cried out and said, Alas for me, Lord, witness of the widow with whom I dwell, you have afflicted her by putting her son to death.

21 And he breathed upon the child three times and called upon the Lord and said, Lord my God, let the life of this child return to him.

22 And it happened thus, and the child cried out.

23 And he brought him down from the upper room into the house and gave him to his mother; and Eliou said, See, your son lives.

24 And the woman said to Eliou, Behold, I know that you are a man of God and that the word of the Lord in your mouth is true.

Chapter 18

1 And it happened after many days that the word of the Lord came to Eliou in the third year, saying, Go and appear to Achaab, and I shall give rain upon the face of the earth.

2 And Eliou went to appear to Achaab. And the famine was severe in Samaria.

3 And Achaab called Abdiou the steward; [and Abdiou greatly feared the Lord,

4 and it happened when Jezabel struck the prophets of the Lord that Abdiou took a hundred men, prophets, and hid them fifty each in a cave and fed them with bread and water.]

5 And Achaab said to Abdiou, Come, let us go through the land to the springs of water and the brooks, if perhaps we may find grass and preserve horses and mules, and they shall not perish from among the livestock.

6 And they divided the way for themselves to traverse it; Achaab went alone by one way, and Abdiou went alone by another way.

7 And Abdiou was alone on the road, and Eliou came alone to meet him; and Abdiou hastened and fell on his face and said, Are you himself, my lord Eliou?

8 And Eliou said to him, I am. Go, say to your lord, Behold, Eliou.

9 And Abdiou said, What have I sinned, that you give your servant into the hand of Achaab to put me to death?

10 As the Lord your God lives, if there is a nation or kingdom to which my lord has not sent to seek you; and they said, He is not here; and he burned the kingdom and its territories, because he had not found you.

11 And now you say, Go, announce to your lord, Behold, Eliou.

12 And it shall be when I depart from you that a spirit of the Lord will lift you to a land I do not know, and I shall go in to tell Achaab, and he will kill me; and your servant has feared the Lord from his youth.

13 Was it not reported to my lord what I did when Jezabel killed the prophets of the Lord, that I hid a hundred men of the Lord's prophets, fifty each in a cave, and fed them with bread and water?

14 And now you say to me, Go, say to your lord, Behold, Eliou; and he will kill me.

15 And Eliou said, As the Lord of the forces lives, before whom I stand, I shall appear to him today.

16 And Abdiou went to meet Achaab and reported to him; and Achaab ran out and went to meet Eliou.

17 And it happened when Achaab saw Eliou that Achaab said to Eliou, Are you the one who turns Israel astray?

18 And Eliou said, I do not turn Israel astray, but rather you and your father's house, because you abandon the Lord your God and you went after the Baalim.

19 And now send, gather all Israel to me at Mount Carmel and the four hundred and fifty prophets of shame and the four hundred prophets of the groves who eat at Jezabel's table.

20 And Achaab sent to all Israel and gathered all the prophets to Mount Carmel.

21 And Eliou brought them near to all and said to them, How long will you limp on both knees? If the Lord is God, go after him; but if Baal himself is, go after him. And the people did not answer a word.

22 And Eliou said to the people, I alone remain a prophet of the Lord, and the prophets of Baal are four hundred and fifty men, and the prophets of the grove four hundred.

23 Let them give us two oxen, and let them choose one for themselves and cut it up and place it upon the wood, but place no fire; and I shall prepare the other ox and certainly place no fire.

24 And call in the name of your gods, and I shall call in the name of the Lord my God; and the god who hears by fire, he is God. And all the people answered and said, The word you have spoken is good.

25 And Eliou said to the prophets of shame, Choose the one calf for yourselves and prepare it first, for you are many, and call in the name of your god, but place no fire.

26 And they took the calf and prepared it and called in the name of Baal from morning until noon and said, Hear us, Baal, hear us; and there was no voice and no hearing; and they ran around upon the altar which they made.

27 And it happened at noon that Eliou the Thesbite mocked them and said, Call with a great voice, for he is a god, for he has idle talk, and perhaps at the same time he is giving an oracle, or perhaps he is asleep and will wake up.

28 And they called with a great voice and cut themselves according to their custom with swords and lances until blood poured over them.

29 And they prophesied until the evening passed. And it happened at the time for the sacrifice to go up that there was no voice, and Eliou the Thesbite spoke to the prophets of abhorrent things, saying, Move aside now, and I shall prepare my whole burnt offering; and they moved aside and went away.

30 And Eliou said to the people, Bring them near to me; and all the people came near to him.

31 And Eliou took twelve stones according to the number of the tribes of Israel, as the Lord had spoken to him, saying, Israel shall be your name.

32 And he built the stones in the name of the Lord and repaired the torn-down altar and made a thaala around the altar holding two measures of seed.

33 And he piled the split wood upon the altar which he made and cut up the whole burnt offering and placed it upon the split wood and piled it upon the altar.

34 And he said, Bring me four jars of water and pour them upon the whole burnt offering and upon the split wood; and they did so. And he said, Do it a second time; and they did it a second time. And he said, Do it a third time; and they did it a third time.

35 And the water flowed around the altar, and they filled the thaala with water.

36 And Eliou cried out to heaven and said, Lord God of Abraham and Isaac and Israel, hear me, Lord, hear me today by fire, and let all this people know that you are the Lord God of Israel and that I am your servant and that for your sake I have done these works.

37 Hear me, Lord, hear me by fire, and let this people know that you are the Lord God and that you turned the heart of this people back.

38 And fire fell from the Lord out of heaven and consumed the whole burnt offering and the split wood and the water in the thaala, and the fire rolled up the stones and the dust.

39 And all the people fell on their faces and said, Truly the Lord is God; he is God.

40 And Eliou said to the people, Seize the prophets of Baal; let none of them be saved. And they seized them, and Eliou brought them down to the brook Kison and slaughtered them there.

41 And Eliou said to Achaab, Go up and eat and drink, for there is a sound of the feet of rain.

42 And Achaab went up to eat and drink, and Eliou went up on Carmel and bent toward the earth and put his face between his knees.

43 And he said to his young servant, Go up and look toward the sea. And the young servant looked and said, There is nothing. And Eliou said, Return seven times; and the young servant returned seven times.

44 And it happened on the seventh time, and behold, a small cloud like the track of a man was bringing up water; and he said, Go up and say to Achaab, Harness your chariot and go down, lest the rain overtake you.

45 And it happened in a moment that the sky grew dark with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain; and Achaab wept and went to Jezrael.

46 And the hand of the Lord was upon Eliou, and he tightened his waist and ran before Achaab as far as Jezrael.

Chapter 19

1 And Achaab reported to Jezabel his wife all that Eliou did and how he killed the prophets with the sword.

2 And Jezabel sent to Eliou and said, If you are Eliou and I am Jezabel, may God do thus to me and thus add, for at this hour tomorrow I shall make your life like the life of one of them.

3 And Eliou feared and arose and went away for his own life and came to Bersabee of Judah and left his young servant there.

4 And he went into the wilderness a day's journey and came and sat beneath one rathm and asked for his life to die and said, Let it suffice now; take my life from me, Lord, for I am not better than my fathers.

5 And he lay down and slept there beneath a plant, and behold, someone touched him and said to him, Arise and eat.

6 And Eliou looked, and behold, at his head was a spelt cake and a flask of water; and he arose and ate and drank. And turning back, he lay down.

7 And the angel of the Lord returned a second time and touched him and said to him, Arise, eat, for the journey is long from you.

8 And he arose and ate and drank; and he went in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights as far as Mount Choreb.

9 And he went into the cave there and lodged there; and behold, a word of the Lord came to him and said, What are you doing here, Eliou?

10 And Eliou said, I have been very zealous for the Lord Almighty, for the sons of Israel have abandoned you; they dug down your altars and killed your prophets with the sword, and I alone remain, and they seek my life to take it.

11 And he said, You shall go out tomorrow and stand before the Lord on the mountain; behold, the Lord shall pass by. And a great strong wind breaking apart mountains and crushing rocks before the Lord, but the Lord was not in the wind; and after the wind an earthquake, but the Lord was not in the earthquake;

12 and after the earthquake fire, but the Lord was not in the fire; and after the fire a voice of a gentle breeze, and there was the Lord.

13 And it happened when Eliou heard that he covered his face with his sheepskin and went out and stood below the cave; and behold, a voice came to him and said, What are you doing here, Eliou?

14 And Eliou said, I have been very zealous for the Lord Almighty, for the sons of Israel have abandoned your covenant; they pulled down your altars and killed your prophets with the sword, and I alone remain, and they seek my life to take it.

15 And the Lord said to him, Go, return to your way and you shall reach the road of the wilderness of Damascus and anoint Azael as king of Syria.

16 And you shall anoint Jou son of Namessi as king over Israel, and you shall anoint Elisaie son of Saphat from Abelmaoula as prophet in your place.

17 And it shall be that Jou will put to death the one saved from the sword of Azael, and Elisaie will put to death the one saved from the sword of Jou.

18 And you shall leave in Israel seven thousand men, all knees that have not bent a knee to Baal, and every mouth that has not bowed to him.

19 And he departed from there and found Elisaie son of Saphat, and he was plowing with oxen, twelve pairs of oxen before him and he among the twelve, and he came to him and threw his sheepskin upon him.

20 And Elisaie left the oxen and ran after Eliou and said, I shall kiss my father and follow after you; and Eliou said, Return, for I have done to you.

21 And he returned from following him and took the pairs of oxen and sacrificed and cooked them with the equipment of the oxen and gave to the people, and they ate; and he arose and went after Eliou and ministered to him.

Chapter 20

1 And Nabouthai the Jezraelite had a vineyard beside the threshing floor of Achaab king of Samaria.

2 And Achaab spoke to Nabouthai, saying, Give me your vineyard and it shall become a garden of vegetables for me, for it is nearer to my house; and I shall give you another vineyard better than it. But if it pleases you, I shall give you silver in exchange for this vineyard of yours, and it shall become a garden of vegetables for me.

3 And Nabouthai said to Achaab, May it not happen to me from my God to give you the inheritance of my fathers.

4 And Achaab's spirit became troubled, and he lay on his bed and covered his face and did not eat bread.

5 And Jezabel his wife came in to him and spoke to him, Why is your spirit troubled and why are you not eating bread?

6 And he said to her, Because I spoke to Nabouthai the Jezraelite, saying, Give me your vineyard for silver; but if you wish, I shall give you another vineyard instead of it; and he said, I shall not give you the inheritance of my fathers.

7 And Jezabel his wife said to him, Do you now thus act as king over Israel? Arise, eat bread and become yourself; I shall give you the vineyard of Nabouthai the Jezraelite.

8 And she wrote a letter in Achaab's name and sealed it with his seal and sent the letter to the elders and the free men who dwelt with Nabouthai.

9 And in the letters it was written, saying, Proclaim a fast and seat Nabouthai at the head of the people.

10 And seat two men, sons of lawless men, opposite him, and let them bear witness against him, saying, He blessed God and king. And let them bring him out and stone him, and let him die.

11 And the men of his city, the elders and free men dwelling in his city, did as Jezabel sent to them, as was written in the letters which she sent to them.

12 They proclaimed a fast and seated Nabouthai at the head of the people.

13 And two men, sons of lawless men, came and sat opposite him and bore witness against him, saying, You blessed God and king; and they led him outside the city and stoned him with stones, and he died.

14 And they sent to Jezabel, saying, Nabouthai has been stoned and has died.

15 And it happened when Jezabel heard that she said to Achaab, Arise, inherit the vineyard of Nabouthai the Jezraelite, who did not give it to you for silver, for Nabouthai is not living; he has died.

16 And it happened when Achaab heard that Nabouthai the Jezraelite had died that he tore his garments and put on sackcloth; and after these things Achaab arose and went down to the vineyard of Nabouthai the Jezraelite to inherit it.

17 And the Lord said to Eliou the Thesbite, saying,

18 Arise and go down to meet Achaab king of Israel who is in Samaria; behold, he is in Nabouthai's vineyard, for he has gone down there to inherit it.

19 And speak to him, saying, Thus says the Lord: As you murdered and inherited, therefore thus says the Lord: In every place where the swine and the dogs licked Nabouthai's blood, there the dogs shall lick your blood, and the prostitutes shall bathe in your blood.

20 And Achaab said to Eliou, Have you found me, my enemy? And he said, I have found you, because you have sold yourself in vain to do evil before the Lord, to provoke him.

21 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I bring evils upon you and shall burn up after you and destroy of Achaab one who urinates against a wall and one confined and one abandoned in Israel.

22 And I shall make your house like the house of Jeroboam son of Nabat and like the house of Baasa son of Achia because of the provocations with which you provoked and caused Israel to sin.

23 And concerning Jezabel the Lord spoke, saying, The dogs shall eat her by the outer wall of Jezrael.

24 The dogs shall eat the one of Achaab who dies in the city, and the birds of heaven shall eat the one of his who dies in the plain.

25 But Achaab was vainly sold to do evil before the Lord, as Jezabel his wife turned him aside.

26 And he became very abhorrent in going after abominations according to all that the Amorite did, whom the Lord destroyed from before the sons of Israel.

27 And concerning the matter, when Achaab was pierced before the Lord and went about weeping, he tore his tunic and girded sackcloth upon his body and fasted and wore sackcloth on the day when he struck Nabouthai the Jezraelite.

28 And the word of the Lord came by the hand of his servant Eliou concerning Achaab, and the Lord said,

29 Have you seen how Achaab was pierced before me? I shall not bring the evil in his days, but in the days of his son I shall bring the evil.

Chapter 21

1 And the son of Ader gathered all his force and went up and besieged Samaria, and thirty-two kings were with him and every horse and chariot; and they went up and besieged Samaria and fought against it.

2 And he sent to Achaab king of Israel in the city

3 and said to him, Thus says the son of Ader: Your silver and your gold are mine, and your women and your children are mine.

4 And the king of Israel answered and said, As you have spoken, my lord king, I am yours and all that is mine.

5 And the messengers returned and said, Thus says the son of Ader: I have sent to you, saying, Your silver and your gold and your women and your children you shall give me.

6 For at this hour tomorrow I shall send my servants to you, and they shall search your house and the houses of your servants, and whatever their eyes desire, upon which they lay their hands, they shall take.

7 And the king of Israel called all the elders and said, Know now and see that this man seeks evil, for he sent to me concerning my women and my sons and my daughters; my silver and my gold I did not withhold from him.

8 And the elders and all the people said to him, Do not listen and do not consent.

9 And he said to the messengers of the son of Ader, Say to your lord, All that you first sent to your servant I shall do, but this matter I cannot do. And the men departed and returned a word to him.

10 And the son of Ader sent back to him, saying, May God do thus to me and thus add, if the dust of Samaria shall suffice for the foxes of all the people on foot with me.

11 And the king of Israel answered and said, Let it suffice; let not the bent man boast like the upright man.

12 And it happened when he answered him with this word that he and all the kings with him were drinking in tents; and he said to his servants, Build a palisade; and they placed a palisade against the city.

13 And behold, one prophet approached the king of Israel and said, Thus says the Lord: Have you seen all this great crowd? Behold, I give it into your hands today, and you shall know that I am the Lord.

14 And Achaab said, By whom? And he said, Thus says the Lord: By the young servants of the rulers of the territories. And Achaab said, Who shall begin the war? And he said, You.

15 And Achaab inspected the young servants of the rulers of the territories, and they were two hundred and thirty; and after these he inspected the people, every son of strength, sixty thousand.

16 And he went out at noon; and the son of Ader was drinking himself drunk in Sokchoth, he and the kings, thirty-two kings aiding him.

17 And the young servants of the rulers of the territories went out first. And they sent and reported to the king of Syria, saying, Men have gone out from Samaria.

18 And he said to them, If these come out for peace, seize them alive; and if for war, seize them alive.

19 And let not the young servants of the rulers of the territories go out from the city. And the force behind them

20 struck, each one the man beside him, and each one struck a second time the man beside him, and Syria fled, and Israel pursued them; and the son of Ader king of Syria escaped on a horse of a horseman.

21 And the king of Israel went out and took all the horses and chariots and struck a great blow in Syria.

22 And the prophet approached the king of Israel and said, Be strong and know and see what you shall do, for at the turn of the year the son of Ader king of Syria will come up against you.

23 And the servants of the king of Syria said, The God of Israel is a god of mountains and not a god of valleys; therefore he prevailed over us. But if we fight them on level ground, surely we shall prevail over them.

24 And do this thing: remove the kings, each from his place, and put satraps in their stead,

25 and we shall replace for you a force corresponding to the force that fell from you, and horse for horse and chariots for chariots; and we shall fight against them on level ground and prevail over them. And he listened to their voice and did so.

26 And it happened at the turn of the year that the son of Ader inspected Syria and went up to Apheka for war against Israel.

27 And the sons of Israel were inspected and came to meet them; and Israel encamped opposite them like two flocks of goats, and Syria filled the land.

28 And the man of God approached and said to the king of Israel, Thus says the Lord: Because Syria said, The Lord God of Israel is a God of mountains and he is not a God of valleys, I shall give this great force into your hand, and you shall know that I am the Lord.

29 And these encamped opposite those for seven days; and it happened on the seventh day that the battle drew near, and Israel struck Syria, a hundred thousand foot soldiers in one day.

30 And the remainder fled into Apheka, into the city, and the wall fell upon twenty-seven thousand men of the remainder. And the son of Ader fled and entered into the house of the bedchamber, into the storeroom.

31 And he said to his servants, I know that the kings of Israel are merciful kings. Let us put sackcloth on our waists and ropes on our heads and go out to the king of Israel; perhaps he will preserve our lives.

32 And they girded sackcloth on their waists and put ropes on their heads and said to the king of Israel, Your servant the son of Ader says, Let my life live. And he said, Is he still alive? He is my brother.

33 And the men took it as an omen and hastened and caught up the word from his mouth and said, Your brother, the son of Ader. And he said, Go in and take him. And the son of Ader came out to him, and they brought him up to him upon the chariot.

34 And he said to him, The cities that my father took from your father I shall restore to you, and you shall establish exits for yourself in Damascus, as my father established in Samaria; and I shall send you away under a covenant. And he made a covenant with him and sent him away.

35 And a certain man of the sons of the prophets said to his neighbor by the word of the Lord, Strike me, please. And the man was unwilling to strike him.

36 And he said to him, Because you did not listen to the voice of the Lord, behold, as you run away from me a lion will strike you. And he went away from him, and a lion found him and struck him.

37 And he found another man and said, Strike me, please. And the man struck him, striking and crushing him.

38 And the prophet went and stood before the king of Israel on the road and bound his eyes with a band.

39 And it happened as the king was passing by that this man cried out to the king and said, Your servant went out to the army of the war, and behold, a man brought a man to me and said to me, Guard this man; but if he escapes by escaping, then your life shall be in place of his life, or you shall pay a talent of silver.

40 And it happened that your servant looked around here and there, and he was not there. And the king of Israel said to him, Behold also the ambushes; in my presence you have murdered.

41 And he hastened and removed the band from his eyes, and the king of Israel recognized him, that he was of the prophets.

42 And he said to him, Thus says the Lord: Because you brought a man devoted to destruction out of your hand, your life shall be in place of his life and your people in place of his people.

43 And the king of Israel departed confused and dispirited and came to Samaria.

Chapter 22

1 And he remained three years, and there was no war between Syria and Israel.

2 And it happened in the third year that Josaphat king of Judah came down to the king of Israel.

3 And the king of Israel said to his servants, Do you know that Remmath Galaad belongs to us, and we are silent about taking it from the hand of the king of Syria?

4 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat, Will you go up with us to Remmath Galaad for war? And Josaphat said, As I am, so are you; as my people, your people; as my horses, your horses.

5 And Josaphat king of Judah said to the king of Israel, Inquire of the Lord today, please.

6 And the king of Israel gathered all the prophets, about four hundred men, and the king said to them, Shall I go to Remmath Galaad for war, or shall I hold back? And they said, Go up, and the Lord will surely give it into the hands of the king.

7 And Josaphat said to the king of Israel, Is there no prophet of the Lord here, that we may inquire of the Lord through him?

8 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat, There is still one man through whom to inquire of the Lord, and I have hated him because he does not speak good concerning me, but only evil: Michaias son of Iemla. And Josaphat king of Judah said, Let the king not say so.

9 And the king of Israel called one eunuch and said, Quickly, Michaias son of Iemla.

10 And the king of Israel and Josaphat king of Judah were sitting, each on his throne, armed, at the gates of Samaria, and all the prophets were prophesying before them.

11 And Sedekias son of Chanana made for himself horns of iron and said, Thus says the Lord: With these you shall gore Syria until it is brought to an end.

12 And all the prophets prophesied thus, saying, Go up to Remmath Galaad, and it will prosper, and the Lord will give into your hands even the king of Syria.

13 And the messenger who had gone to call Michaias spoke to him, saying, Behold now, all the prophets speak good concerning the king with one mouth; let your words also be like the words of one of these, and speak good.

14 And Michaias said, As the Lord lives, whatever the Lord says to me, that I shall speak.

15 And he came to the king, and the king said to him, Michaias, shall I go up to Remmath Galaad for war, or shall I hold back? And he said, Go up, and it will prosper, and the Lord will give it into the hand of the king.

16 And the king said to him, How many times do I put you under oath to speak truth to me in the name of the Lord?

17 And Michaias said, Not so. I have seen all Israel scattered on the mountains like a flock that has no shepherd, and the Lord said, These have no master; let each return to his house in peace.

18 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat king of Judah, Did I not say to you, He prophesies no good for me, but only evil?

19 And Michaias said, Not so, not I; hear the word of the Lord, not so: I saw the Lord God of Israel sitting upon his throne, and all the host of heaven stood around him, on his right and on his left.

20 And the Lord said, Who will deceive Achaab king of Israel, so that he will go up and fall at Remmath Galaad? And this one said thus and that one thus.

21 And a spirit came out and stood before the Lord and said, I shall deceive him. And the Lord said to it, By what means?

22 And it said, I shall go out and be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets. And he said, You shall deceive him and indeed be able; go out and do so.

23 And now behold, the Lord has put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these prophets of yours, and the Lord has spoken evil against you.

24 And Sedekiou son of Chanana approached and struck Michaias on the jaw and said, What spirit of the Lord is it that spoke in you?

25 And Michaias said, Behold, you shall see on that day when you enter the innermost storeroom to hide.

26 And the king of Israel said, Take Michaias and return him to Emer the ruler of the city, and to Joas the king's son

27 say to put this man in prison and to feed him bread of affliction and water of affliction until I return in peace.

28 And Michaias said, If you do return in peace, the Lord has not spoken in me.

29 And the king of Israel went up, and Josaphat king of Judah with him, to Remmath Galaad.

30 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat king of Judah, I shall disguise myself and enter into the battle, and you put on my clothing. And the king of Israel disguised himself and entered into the battle.

31 And the king of Syria commanded the thirty-two commanders of his chariots, saying, Do not fight small or great, but only the king of Israel.

32 And it happened when the commanders of the chariots saw Josaphat king of Judah that they said, This appears to be the king of Israel; and they surrounded him to fight, and Josaphat cried out.

33 And it happened when the commanders of the chariots saw that this was not the king of Israel that they turned away from him.

34 And one drew the bow with good aim and struck the king of Israel between the lung and the breastplate. And he said to his charioteer, Turn your hands and bring me out of the battle, for I am wounded.

35 And the battle turned on that day, and the king stood upon the chariot opposite Syria from morning until evening, and he was pouring the blood from the wound into the hollow of the chariot; and he died in the evening, and the blood of the rout was flowing as far as the hollow of the chariot.

36 And the army herald stood as the sun was setting, saying, Each to his own city and to his own land,

37 for the king is dead. And they came to Samaria and buried the king in Samaria.

38 And they washed the chariot at the spring of Samaria, and the swine and the dogs licked up the blood, and the prostitutes bathed in the blood, according to the word of the Lord that he had spoken.

39 And the rest of the deeds of Achaab and all that he did, and the ivory house that he built, and all the cities that he made, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

40 And Achaab slept with his fathers, and Ochozias his son reigned in his stead.

41 And Josaphat son of Asa reigned over Judah. He reigned in the fourth year of Achaab king of Israel.

42 Josaphat was a son of thirty-five years when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Azouba daughter of Selei.

43 And he walked in all the way of Asa his father; he did not turn aside from it, doing what was right in the eyes of the Lord;

44 but he did not remove the high places; the people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places.

45 And Josaphat made peace with the king of Israel.

46 And the rest of the deeds of Josaphat and his acts of power, as many as he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

51 And Josaphat slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father; and Joram his son reigned in his stead.

52 And Ochozias son of Achaab reigned over Israel in Samaria in the seventeenth year of Josaphat king of Judah; and he reigned in Israel two years.

53 And he did evil before the Lord and walked in the way of Achaab his father and in the way of Jezabel his mother and in the sins of the house of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

54 And he served the Baals and worshiped them and provoked the Lord God of Israel according to all that had happened before him.

2 Kings

Chapter 1

1 And Moab rebelled against Israel after Achaab died.

2 And Ochozias fell through the lattice in his upper room in Samaria and became ill. And he sent messengers and said to them, Come and inquire of Baal Myian, god of Akkaron, whether I shall live from this illness of mine; and they went to inquire through him.

3 And an angel of the Lord spoke to Eliou the Thesbite, saying, Arise, come to meet the messengers of Ochozias king of Samaria, and speak to them: Is it because there is no God in Israel that you go to inquire of Baal Myian, god of Akkaron?

4 And not so; for thus says the Lord: The bed onto which you went up there, you shall not come down from it, for there you shall surely die. And Eliou went and spoke to them.

5 And the messengers returned to him, and he said to them, Why have you returned?

6 And they said to him, A man came up to meet us and said to us, Come, return to the king who sent you and speak to him: Thus says the Lord: Is it because there is no God in Israel that you are going to seek Baal Myian, god of Akkaron? Not so; the bed onto which you went up there, you shall not come down from it, for you shall surely die.

7 And he spoke to them, saying, What was the appearance of the man who came up to meet you and spoke these words to you?

8 And they said to him, A hairy man, with a leather belt girded about his waist. And he said, This is Eliou the Thesbite.

9 And he sent to him a leader, a captain of fifty, and his fifty; and he went up and came to him, and behold, Eliou was sitting on the top of the mountain. And the captain of fifty spoke to him and said, Man of God, the king has summoned you; come down.

10 And Eliou answered and said to the captain of fifty, And if I am a man of God, fire will come down from heaven and devour you and your fifty. And fire came down from heaven and devoured him and his fifty.

11 And the king again sent to him another captain of fifty and his fifty, and he went up, and the captain of fifty spoke to him and said, Man of God, thus says the king: Come down quickly.

12 And Eliou answered and spoke to him and said, If I am a man of God, fire will come down from heaven and devour you and your fifty. And fire came down from heaven and devoured him and his fifty.

13 And the king again sent a third leader, a captain of fifty, and his fifty; and the third captain of fifty came to him and bent upon his knees before Eliou and entreated him and spoke to him and said, Man of God, let my life and the life of these fifty servants of yours be precious in your eyes;

14 behold, fire came down from heaven and devoured the first two captains of fifty and their fifties, and now let the life of your servants be precious in your eyes.

15 And an angel of the Lord spoke to Eliou and said, Go down with him; do not be afraid of them. And Eliou arose and went down with him to the king.

16 And he spoke to him, and Eliou said, Thus says the Lord: Why did you send messengers to seek Baal Myian, god of Akkaron? Not so; the bed onto which you went up there, you shall not come down from it, for you shall surely die.

17 And he died according to the word of the Lord that Eliou had spoken.

18 And the rest of the deeds of Ochozias, as many as he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

18 a And Joram son of Achaab reigns over Israel in Samaria for twelve years in the eighteenth year of Josaphat king of Judah.

19 And he did evil before the Lord, though not like his brothers or like his mother;

20 and he removed the pillars of Baal, which his father had made, and crushed them; but he clung to the sins of the house of Jeroboam, who caused Israel to sin; he did not depart from them.

21 And the Lord was angry with anger against the house of Achaab.

Chapter 2

1 And it happened when the Lord was taking Eliou up in a whirlwind as into heaven, that Eliou and Elisaie went from Galgala.

2 And Eliou said to Elisaie, Stay here, please, for the Lord has sent me as far as Bethel. And Elisaie said, As the Lord lives and as your soul lives, I shall not leave you. And they came to Bethel.

3 And the sons of the prophets in Bethel came to Elisaie and said to him, Do you know that the Lord today is taking your master from above your head? And he said, I too know; be silent.

4 And Eliou said to Elisaie, Stay here, please, for the Lord has sent me to Jericho. And Elisaie said, As the Lord lives and as your soul lives, I shall not abandon you. And they came to Jericho.

5 And the sons of the prophets in Jericho approached Elisaie and said to him, Do you know that today the Lord is taking your master from above your head? And he said, Indeed I too know; be silent.

6 And Eliou said to him, Stay here, please, for the Lord has sent me as far as the Jordan. And Elisaie said, As the Lord lives and as your soul lives, I shall not abandon you. And they both went.

7 And fifty men of the sons of the prophets stood opposite at a distance, and the two stood at the Jordan.

8 And Eliou took his sheepskin mantle and rolled it up and struck the water, and the water was divided this way and that, and the two crossed in the wilderness.

9 And it happened when they crossed that Eliou said to Elisaie, Ask what I shall do for you before I am taken up from you. And Elisaie said, Let there be, please, a double portion of your spirit upon me.

10 And Eliou said, You have made a hard request. If you see me being taken up from you, then it shall be so for you; and if not, it shall certainly not happen.

11 And it happened as they went along and talked, behold, a chariot of fire and horses of fire separated the two, and Eliou was taken up in a whirlwind as into heaven.

12 And Elisaie saw and cried out, Father, father, chariot of Israel and its horseman! And he saw him no more, and he grasped his garments and tore them into two tears.

13 And he lifted up the sheepskin mantle of Eliou, which had fallen from above Elisaie, and Elisaie returned and stood on the bank of the Jordan;

14 and he took the sheepskin mantle of Eliou, which had fallen from above him, and struck the water, and it did not part. And he said, Where is the God of Eliou, affo? And he struck the waters, and they were split this way and that, and Elisaie crossed.

15 And the sons of the prophets in Jericho saw him opposite and said, The spirit of Eliou has rested upon Elisaie. And they came to meet him and bowed to him to the ground.

16 And they said to him, Behold now, with your servants are fifty men, sons of strength; let them go, please, and seek your master, lest the spirit of the Lord have lifted him and thrown him into the Jordan or upon one of the mountains or upon one of the hills. And Elisaie said, Do not send them.

17 And they pressed him until he was ashamed, and he said, Send them. And they sent fifty men, and they searched three days and did not find him;

18 and they returned to him while he was staying in Jericho, and Elisaie said, Did I not say to you, Do not go?

19 And the men of the city said to Elisaie, Behold, the dwelling place of the city is good, as my lord sees, but the waters are bad and the land is barren.

20 And Elisaie said, Bring me a new small jar and put salt there. And they brought it to him.

21 And Elisaie went out to the outlet of the waters and threw salt there and said, Thus says the Lord: I have healed these waters; no longer shall death and barrenness come from there.

22 And the waters were healed to this day according to the word of Elisaie that he spoke.

23 And he went up from there to Bethel; and as he was going up on the road, small children came out of the city and mocked him and said to him, Go up, bald one, go up.

24 And he turned behind them and saw them and cursed them in the name of the Lord, and behold, two bears came out of the thicket and tore forty-two children from among them.

25 And he went from there to Mount Carmel and returned from there to Samaria.

Chapter 3

1 And Joram son of Achaab reigned in Israel in the eighteenth year of Josaphat king of Judah, and he reigned twelve years.

2 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord, though not like his father and not like his mother, and he removed the pillars of Baal that his father had made;

3 but he clung to the sin of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin; he did not depart from it.

4 And Mosa king of Moab was a noked, and at the revolt he rendered to the king of Israel a hundred thousand lambs and a hundred thousand rams with fleeces.

5 And it happened after Achaab died that the king of Moab rebelled against the king of Israel.

6 And King Joram went out from Samaria on that day and inspected Israel;

7 and he went and sent to Josaphat king of Judah, saying, The king of Moab has rebelled against me; will you go with me to Moab for war? And he said, I shall go up; I am like you, my people like your people, my horses like your horses.

8 And he said, By which road shall I go up? And he said, By the wilderness road of Edom.

9 And the king of Israel and the king of Judah and the king of Edom went, and they went around on a road of seven days, and there was no water for the camp and for the beasts following in their steps.

10 And the king of Israel said, Alas, for the Lord has called these three kings who are passing through to give them into the hand of Moab.

11 And Josaphat said, Is there no prophet of the Lord here, that we may seek the Lord from him? And one of the servants of the king of Israel answered and said, Here is Elisaie son of Saphat, who poured water upon Eliou's hands.

12 And Josaphat said, The word of the Lord is with him. And the king of Israel and Josaphat king of Judah and the king of Edom went down to him.

13 And Elisaie said to the king of Israel, What is there between me and you? Go to your father's prophets. And the king of Israel said to him, No, for the Lord has called these three kings to deliver them into the hands of Moab.

14 And Elisaie said, As the Lord of hosts lives, before whom I stand, if I did not regard the face of Josaphat king of Judah, would I look at you or see you?

15 And now bring me someone who plays. And it happened as the player played that the hand of the Lord came upon him,

16 and he said, Thus says the Lord: Make this torrent bed pits upon pits;

17 for thus says the Lord: You shall see no wind and shall see no rain, yet this torrent bed shall be filled with water, and you and your possessions and your beasts shall drink;

18 and this is a light thing in the eyes of the Lord, and I shall deliver Moab into your hand,

19 and you shall strike every fortified city and fell every good tree and stop up every spring of water and ruin every good portion with stones.

20 And it happened in the morning, as the sacrifice was going up, behold, waters came from the direction of Edom, and the land was filled with water.

21 And all Moab heard that the kings had gone up to fight them, and they called out everyone who girded on a belt and upward, and stood at the border.

22 And they rose early in the morning, and the sun rose upon the waters; and Moab saw the waters opposite, red like blood,

23 and they said, This is blood of the sword; the kings have fought and each man has struck his neighbor, and now to the spoil, Moab.

24 And they entered the camp of Israel, and Israel rose and struck Moab, and they fled before them. And they entered, going in and striking Moab,

25 and they pulled down the cities, and upon every good portion each man threw a stone and filled it, and they stopped up every spring of water and felled every good tree, until leaving the stones of the wall pulled down; and the slingers surrounded and struck it.

26 And the king of Moab saw that the battle had prevailed against him, and he took with him seven hundred men who drew the sword to break through to the king of Edom, and they were unable.

27 And he took his firstborn son, who reigned in his stead, and offered him as a whole burnt offering upon the wall; and great regret came upon Israel, and they departed from him and returned to the land.

Chapter 4

1 And one woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisaie, saying, Your servant my husband has died, and you know that he was a servant fearing the Lord; and the creditor has come to take my two sons as slaves for himself.

2 And Elisaie said, What shall I do for you? Tell me what you have in the house. And she said, Your servant has nothing in the house except oil with which I shall anoint myself.

3 And he said to her, Go, ask for vessels for yourself from outside, from all your neighbors, empty vessels; do not make them few,

4 and you shall enter and shut the door behind you and your sons and pour into these vessels, and what is filled you shall take away.

5 And she went from him and did so and shut the door behind herself and her sons; they brought them near to her, and she poured,

6 until the vessels were filled. And she said to her sons, Bring another vessel to me. And they said to her, There is no other vessel. And the oil stopped.

7 And she came and told the man of God, and Elisaie said, Go and sell the oil and pay your interest, and you and your sons shall live on the remaining oil.

8 And a day came when Elisaie passed through Souman, and a great woman was there and pressed him to eat bread. And it happened after some time that whenever he entered he turned aside to eat there.

9 And the woman said to her husband, Behold now, I know that this is a holy man of God who passes by us continually;

10 let us make for him a small upper room, and let us put there for him a bed and a table and a stool and a lamp, and when he comes to us he will turn aside there.

11 And a day came when he entered there and turned aside to the upper room and slept there.

12 And he said to Giezi his servant, Call this Somanite woman for me. And he called her, and she stood before him.

13 And he said to him, Say to her, Behold, you have gone through all this trouble for us; what must be done for you? Is there a matter for you with the king or with the commander of the force? And she said, I dwell among my people.

14 And he said, What must be done for her? And Giezi his servant said, Indeed she has no son, and her husband is old.

15 And he called her, and she stood by the door.

16 And Elisaie said to her, At this time, as at the hour, while living, you shall be embracing a son. And she said, No, my lord, do not deceive your servant.

17 And the woman conceived and bore a son at this time, as at the hour, while living, as Elisaie had spoken to her.

18 And the child grew strong; and it happened when the child went out to his father, to the reapers,

19 that he said to his father, My head, my head! And he said to the servant, Carry him to his mother.

20 And he carried him to his mother, and he lay on her knees until noon and died.

21 And she carried him up and laid him on the bed of the man of God and shut the door behind him and went out.

22 And she called her husband and said, Send me one of the servants and one of the donkeys, please, and I shall run as far as the man of God and return.

23 And he said, Why are you going to him today? It is neither a new moon nor a sabbath. And she said, Peace.

24 And she saddled the donkey and said to her servant, Lead on, go; do not hold me back from riding unless I tell you.

25 Come, and she went and came to the man of God at Mount Carmel. And it happened when Elisaie saw her coming that he said to Giezi his servant, Behold, that Somanite woman;

26 now run to meet her and say, Is it peace with you? Is it peace with your husband? Is it peace with the child? And she said, Peace.

27 And she came to Elisaie on the mountain and grasped his feet. And Giezi approached to push her away, and Elisaie said, Leave her, for her soul is in pain within her, and the Lord has hidden it from me and has not told me.

28 And she said, Did I ask my lord for a son? Did I not say, Do not mislead me?

29 And Elisaie said to Giezi, Gird your waist and take my staff in your hand and go; if you meet a man, do not greet him, and if a man greets you, do not answer him; and place my staff on the child's face.

30 And the mother of the child said, As the Lord lives and as your soul lives, I shall not abandon you. And Elisaie arose and went after her.

31 And Giezi went ahead of her and placed the staff on the child's face, and there was no voice and no hearing; and he returned to meet him and told him, saying, The child has not awakened.

32 And Elisaie entered the house, and behold, the child was dead, lying on his bed.

33 And Elisaie entered the house and shut the door behind the two of them and prayed to the Lord;

34 and he went up and lay upon the child and put his mouth upon his mouth and his eyes upon his eyes and his hands upon his hands and bent himself over him, and the child's flesh grew warm.

35 And he returned and walked in the house back and forth and went up and bent himself over the child seven times, and the child opened his eyes.

36 And Elisaie cried out to Giezi and said, Call this Somanite woman. And he called her, and she came in to him. And Elisaie said, Take your son.

37 And the woman came in and fell at his feet and bowed to the ground and took her son and went out.

38 And Elisaie returned to Galgala, and there was famine in the land, and the sons of the prophets were sitting before him. And Elisaie said to his servant, Set up the large cauldron and cook a stew for the sons of the prophets.

39 And one went out to the field to gather arioth and found a vine in the field and gathered from it a wild cluster, filling his garment, and threw it into the cauldron of stew, for they did not know.

40 And he poured it out for the men to eat, and it happened as they ate from the stew that, behold, they cried out and said, Death is in the cauldron, man of God! And they could not eat.

41 And he said, Take flour and throw it into the cauldron. And Elisaie said to Giezi his servant, Pour it out for the people, and let them eat. And there was no longer any evil thing in the cauldron.

42 And a man came from Baithsarisa and brought to the man of God from the firstfruits twenty barley loaves and cakes of pressed fruit, and he said, Give to the people, and let them eat.

43 And his attendant said, What shall I set this before a hundred men? And he said, Give to the people, and let them eat, for thus says the Lord: They shall eat and leave some.

44 And they ate and left some according to the word of the Lord.

Chapter 5

1 And Naiman commander of the force of Syria was a great man before his master and admired in person, because through him the Lord gave deliverance to Syria; and the man was mighty in strength, afflicted with leprosy.

2 And the Syrians went out in bands and took captive from the land of Israel a little young girl, and she was before the wife of Naiman.

3 And she said to her mistress, If only my master were before the prophet of God in Samaria, then he would remove him from his leprosy.

4 And he went in and reported to his master and said, Thus and thus spoke the girl from the land of Israel.

5 And the king of Syria said to Naiman, Come, go in, and I shall send a letter to the king of Israel. And he went and took in his hand ten talents of silver and six thousand gold pieces and ten changes of garments.

6 And he brought the letter to the king of Israel, saying, And now when this letter comes to you, behold, I have sent to you Naiman my servant, and you shall remove him from his leprosy.

7 And it happened when the king of Israel read the letter that he tore his garments and said, Am I God, to put to death and to make alive, that this man sends to me to remove a man from his leprosy? But know now and see that this man seeks a pretext against me.

8 And it happened when Elisaie heard that the king of Israel had torn his garments that he sent to the king of Israel, saying, Why did you tear your garments? Let Naiman come to me, please, and let him know that there is a prophet in Israel.

9 And Naiman came with horse and chariot and stood at the door of Elisaie's house.

10 And Elisaie sent a messenger to him, saying, Go and wash seven times in the Jordan, and your flesh shall return to you, and you shall be clean.

11 And Naiman became angry and went away and said, Behold, I had said that he would come out to me and stand and call upon the name of his God and put his hand upon the place and remove the leprous condition;

12 are not Abana and Pharphar, rivers of Damascus, better than the Jordan and all the waters of Israel? Shall I not go and wash in them and be clean? And he turned aside and went away in anger.

13 And his servants approached and spoke to him, A great word the prophet spoke to you; would you not do it? And because he said to you, Wash and be clean.

14 And Naiman went down and immersed himself in the Jordan seven times according to the word of Elisaie, and his flesh returned like the flesh of a little child, and he was cleansed.

15 And he returned to Elisaie, he and all his camp, and came and stood and said, Behold now, I know that there is no God in all the earth except in Israel; and now take the blessing from your servant.

16 And Elisaie said, As the Lord lives, before whom I stand, I shall not take it. And he pressed him to take it, but he refused.

17 And Naiman said, And if not, let a load of a pair of mules be given to your servant, and you shall give me from the red earth, for your servant shall no longer make whole burnt offering and sacrifice to other gods, but to the Lord alone;

18 and may the Lord show mercy to your servant when my master enters the house of Remman to worship him and rests upon my hand and I bow in the house of Remman as he bows in the house of Remman; may the Lord show mercy to your servant in this matter.

19 And Elisaie said to Naiman, Go in peace. And he went away from him to debratha of the land.

20 And Giezi the servant of Elisaie said, Behold, my master spared this Syrian Naiman by not taking from his hand what he had brought. As the Lord lives, I shall surely run after him and take something from him.

21 And Giezi pursued Naiman, and Naiman saw him running after him and turned from the chariot to meet him.

22 And he said, Peace. My master sent me, saying, Behold, just now two young men have come to me from Mount Ephraim, from the sons of the prophets; give them, please, a talent of silver and two changes of garments.

23 And Naiman said, Take two talents of silver. And he took it in two bags and two changes of garments and gave them to two of his servants, and they carried them before him.

24 And they came to the dark place, and he took them from their hands and put them in the house and sent the men away.

25 And he himself entered and stood before his master. And Elisaie said to him, Where have you come from, Giezi? And Giezi said, Your servant has gone nowhere at all.

26 And Elisaie said to him, Did not my heart go with you when the man turned from the chariot to meet you? And now you have taken the silver and now you have taken the garments, and with it you shall acquire gardens and olive groves and vineyards and sheep and cattle and male and female servants;

27 and Naiman's leprosy shall cling to you and your offspring forever. And he went out from before him afflicted with leprosy like snow.

Chapter 6

1 And the sons of the prophets said to Elisaie, Behold now, the place where we dwell before you is too narrow for us;

2 let us go as far as the Jordan and take from there, each man, one beam, and make for ourselves a place there to dwell. And he said, Go.

3 And one said, Please, come with your servants. And he said, I shall go.

4 And he went with them, and they came to the Jordan and were cutting the wood.

5 And behold, as one was felling the beam, the iron fell into the water; and he cried out, Alas, master, and it was borrowed.

6 And the man of God said, Where did it fall? And he showed him the place. And he broke off a piece of wood and threw it there, and the iron floated.

7 And he said, Lift it for yourself. And he stretched out his hand and took it.

8 And the king of Syria was warring against Israel and took counsel with his servants, saying, At such and such a place, elmoni, I shall encamp.

9 And Elisaie sent to the king of Israel, saying, Beware of passing through this place, for Syria is hidden there.

10 And the king of Israel sent to the place of which Elisaie had spoken to him and guarded himself from there, not once or twice.

11 And the soul of the king of Syria was shaken over this matter, and he called his servants and said to them, Will you not tell me who betrays me to the king of Israel?

12 And one of his servants said, No, my lord king, for Elisaie the prophet in Israel tells the king of Israel all the words you speak in the storeroom of your bedchamber.

13 And he said, Go, see where he is, and I shall send and take him. And they told him, saying, Behold, he is in Dothaim.

14 And he sent there horse and chariot and a heavy force, and they came by night and surrounded the city.

15 And Elisaie's attendant rose early and went out, and behold, a force was surrounding the city, with horse and chariot, and the servant said to him, Alas, master, what shall we do?

16 And Elisaie said, Do not fear, for those with us are more than those with them.

17 And Elisaie prayed and said, Lord, open the eyes of the servant, and let him see. And the Lord opened his eyes, and he saw, and behold, the mountain was full of horses, and a chariot of fire was around Elisaie.

18 And they came down toward him, and Elisaie prayed to the Lord and said, Strike this nation with inability to see, please. And he struck them with inability to see according to the word of Elisaie.

19 And Elisaie said to them, This is not the city and this is not the road; come after me, and I shall lead you to the man whom you seek. And he led them to Samaria.

20 And it happened when they entered Samaria that Elisaie said, Open their eyes, please, Lord, and let them see. And the Lord opened their eyes, and they saw, and behold, they were in the midst of Samaria.

21 And the king of Israel said when he saw them, Shall I strike them down, father?

22 And he said, You shall not strike them. Unless you have taken them captive with your sword and your bow, do you strike them? Set bread and water before them, and let them eat and drink and go to their master.

23 And he set a great meal before them, and they ate and drank; and he sent them away, and they went to their master. And the Syrian bands no longer continued to come into the land of Israel.

24 And it happened after this that the son of Ader king of Syria gathered all his camp and went up and besieged Samaria.

25 And there was a great famine in Samaria, and behold, they were besieging it, until a donkey's head was fifty shekels of silver and a fourth of a kab of doves' dung was five shekels of silver.

26 And the king of Israel was passing along on the wall, and a woman cried out to him, saying, Save me, my lord king.

27 And he said to her, May the Lord not save you; from where shall I save you? From the threshing floor or from the winepress?

28 And the king said to her, What is the matter with you? And she said, This woman said to me, Give your son and we shall eat him today, and my son we shall eat tomorrow;

29 and we cooked my son and ate him, and I said to her on the second day, Give your son and let us eat him, but she hid her son.

30 And it happened when the king of Israel heard the woman's words that he tore his garments, and as he passed along on the wall the people saw sackcloth against his flesh underneath.

31 And he said, May God do thus to me and add thus if the head of Elisaie shall remain on him today.

32 And Elisaie was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. And he sent a man before him; before the messenger came to him, he himself said to the elders, Do you know that this son of the murderer has sent to take away my head? See, when the messenger comes, shut the door and press him back at the door; is not the sound of his master's feet behind him?

33 While he was still speaking with them, behold, a messenger came down to him and said, Behold, this evil is from the Lord; why should I wait for the Lord any longer?

Chapter 7

1 And Elisaie said, Hear the word of the Lord: Thus says the Lord: At this time tomorrow a measure of fine flour for a shekel and two measures of barley for a shekel at the gates of Samaria.

2 And the officer upon whose hand the king leaned answered Elisaie and said, Behold, even if the Lord makes floodgates in heaven, shall this thing happen? And Elisaie said, Behold, you shall see it with your eyes, but from it you shall not eat.

3 And four men afflicted with leprosy were by the door of the city, and one said to his neighbor, Why are we sitting here until we die?

4 If we say, Let us enter the city, famine is in the city and we shall die there; and if we sit here, we shall also die. And now come, let us fall into the camp of Syria; if they preserve our lives, then we shall live, and if they put us to death, then we shall die.

5 And they arose in the darkness to enter the camp of Syria and came to the edge of the Syrian camp, and behold, there was no man there.

6 And the Lord made the camp of Syria hear the sound of a chariot and the sound of a horse and the sound of a great force, and one said to his brother, Now the king of Israel has hired against us the kings of the Chettites and the kings of Egypt to come against us.

7 And they arose and fled in the darkness and left their tents and their horses and their donkeys in the camp as it was, and fled for their lives.

8 And these men afflicted with leprosy entered as far as the edge of the camp and went into one tent and ate and drank and took from there silver and gold and clothing and went away; and they returned and entered another tent and took from there and went and hid it.

9 And one said to his neighbor, We are not doing right; this day is a day of good news, and we are silent and wait until the light of morning, and we shall find guilt; and now come, let us enter and report to the king's house.

10 And they went in and cried out to the gate of the city and reported to them, saying, We entered the Syrian camp, and behold, there is no man there and no human voice, except a tethered horse and a donkey and their tents as they were.

11 And the gatekeepers cried out and reported inside the king's house.

12 And the king arose at night and said to his servants, Let me tell you what Syria has done to us: they know that we are hungry, and they have gone out from the camp and hidden in the field, saying, They will come out of the city, and we shall catch them alive and enter the city.

13 And one of his servants answered and said, Let them take five of the horses remaining, which have been left here; behold, they are like all the multitude of Israel that is perishing. And we shall send there and see.

14 And they took two horse riders, and the king of Israel sent them after the king of Syria, saying, Go and see.

15 And they went after them as far as the Jordan, and behold, all the road was full of garments and vessels that Syria had thrown away in their alarm; and the messengers returned and reported to the king.

16 And the people went out and plundered the Syrian camp, and a measure of fine flour came to be a shekel and two measures of barley a shekel, according to the word of the Lord.

17 And the king appointed the officer upon whose hand the king leaned over the gate, and the people trampled him in the gate, and he died, as the man of God had spoken when the messenger came down to him.

18 And it happened as Elisaie had spoken to the king, saying, Two measures of barley for a shekel and a measure of fine flour for a shekel, and it shall be at this time tomorrow in the gate of Samaria;

19 and the officer answered Elisaie and said, Behold, even if the Lord makes floodgates in heaven, shall this thing happen? And Elisaie said, Behold, you shall see it with your eyes, but from it you shall not eat.

20 And it happened so, and the people trampled him in the gate, and he died.

Chapter 8

1 And Elisaie spoke to the woman whose son he had revived, saying, Arise and go, you and your household, and sojourn wherever you may sojourn, for the Lord has called a famine upon the land, and indeed it has come upon the land for seven years.

2 And the woman arose and did according to the word of Elisaie and went, she and her household, and sojourned in the land of the foreigners for seven years.

3 And it happened at the end of the seven years that the woman returned from the land of the foreigners to the city and came to cry out to the king concerning her house and her fields.

4 And the king was speaking to Giezi, the servant of Elisaie the man of God, saying, Tell me, please, all the great things that Elisaie did.

5 And it happened as he was telling the king how he had revived a dead son that, behold, the woman whose son Elisaie had revived was crying out to the king concerning her house and her fields; and Giezi said, My lord king, this is the woman and this is her son whom Elisaie revived.

6 And the king questioned the woman, and she told him; and the king gave her a eunuch, saying, Restore all that belongs to her and all the produce of her field from the day she left the land until now.

7 And Elisaie came to Damascus, and the son of Ader king of Syria was ill, and they told him, saying, The man of God has come here.

8 And the king said to Azael, Take manaa in your hand and go to meet the man of God and inquire of the Lord from him, saying, Shall I live from this illness of mine?

9 And Azael went to meet him and took manaa in his hand and all the good things of Damascus, a load of forty camels, and came and stood before him and said to Elisaie, Your son, the son of Ader king of Syria, has sent me to you, saying, Shall I live from this illness of mine?

10 And Elisaie said, Go, say to him, You shall surely live; and the Lord has shown me that you shall surely die.

11 And he stood before his face and fixed it until shame, and the man of God wept.

12 And Azael said, Why does my lord weep? And he said, Because I know what evil things you will do to the sons of Israel: you will send their fortresses into fire and kill their chosen men with the sword and dash their infants and tear open their pregnant women.

13 And Azael said, What is your servant, the dead dog, that he should do this thing? And Elisaie said, The Lord has shown me you reigning over Syria.

14 And he departed from Elisaie and went in to his master, and he said to him, What did Elisaie say to you? And he said, He said to me, You shall surely live.

15 And it happened on the next day that he took the machma and dipped it in water and laid it upon his face, and he died, and Azael reigned in his stead.

16 In the fifth year of Joram son of Achaab king of Israel, Joram son of Josaphat reigned as king of Judah.

17 He was a son of thirty-two years when he began to reign, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.

18 And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as the house of Achaab had done, for a daughter of Achaab was his wife; and he did evil before the Lord.

19 And the Lord was unwilling to destroy Judah because of David his servant, as he had said he would give a lamp to him and to his sons all the days.

20 In his days Edom rebelled from under the hand of Judah and they set a king over themselves.

21 And Joram went up to Sior with all the chariots with him, and it happened when he arose that he struck Edom that had surrounded him and the commanders of the chariots, and the people fled to their tents.

22 And Edom rebelled from under the hand of Judah until this day. Then Lobena rebelled at that time.

23 And the rest of the deeds of Joram and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

24 And Joram slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father; and Ochozias his son reigned in his stead.

25 In the twelfth year of Joram son of Achaab king of Israel, Ochozias son of Joram reigned.

26 Ochozias was a son of twenty-two years when he began to reign, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Gotholia daughter of Ambri king of Israel.

27 And he walked in the way of the house of Achaab and did evil before the Lord as the house of Achaab had done.

28 And he went with Joram son of Achaab to war against Azael king of the foreigners at Remmoth Galaad, and the Syrians struck Joram.

29 And King Joram returned to be healed in Jezrael from the wounds with which they had struck him at Remmoth when he fought against Azael king of Syria; and Ochozias son of Joram went down to see Joram son of Achaab in Jezrael, because he was ill.

Chapter 9

1 And Elisaie the prophet called one of the sons of the prophets and said to him, Gird your waist and take this flask of oil in your hand and go to Remmoth Galaad;

2 and enter there and see there Jou son of Josaphat son of Namessi, and enter and raise him from among his brothers and bring him into the innermost storeroom;

3 and take the flask of oil and pour it upon his head and say, Thus says the Lord: I have anointed you king over Israel. And open the door and flee and do not remain.

4 And the young man, the prophet, went to Remmoth Galaad

5 and entered, and behold, the commanders of the force were sitting, and he said, I have a word for you, commander. And Jou said, For which of all of us? And he said, For you, commander.

6 And he arose and entered the house, and he poured the oil upon his head and said to him, Thus says the Lord God of Israel: I have anointed you king over the people of the Lord, over Israel,

7 and you shall destroy the house of Achaab your master from before me and avenge the blood of my servants the prophets and the blood of all the servants of the Lord at the hand of Jezabel

8 and at the hand of the whole house of Achaab, and you shall destroy from the house of Achaab anyone who urinates against a wall, and one held and one left in Israel;

9 and I shall make the house of Achaab like the house of Jeroboam son of Nabat and like the house of Baasa son of Achia;

10 and the dogs shall devour Jezabel in the portion of Jezrael, and there shall be no one to bury her. And he opened the door and fled.

11 And Jou came out to his master's servants, and they said to him, Is it peace? Why did this afflicted man enter to you? And he said to them, You know the man and his chatter.

12 And they said, Wrong; tell us, please. And Jou said to them, Thus and thus he spoke to me, saying, Thus says the Lord: I have anointed you king over Israel.

13 And when they heard, they hurried and each took his garment and placed it beneath him upon the garem of the steps, and sounded a horn and said, Jou has become king.

14 And Jou son of Josaphat son of Namessi conspired against Joram; and Joram himself was keeping guard at Remmoth Galaad, he and all Israel, against Azael king of Syria,

15 and King Joram had returned to be healed in Jezrael from the wounds with which the Syrians struck him when he fought against Azael king of Syria; and Jou said, If your heart is with me, let no one escape from the city to go and report in Jezrael.

16 And Jou rode and went and came down to Jezrael, for Joram king of Israel was being treated in Jezrael for the arrow wounds with which the Aramin had shot him in Rammath in the war with Azael king of Syria, for he was mighty and a man of strength; and Ochozias king of Judah had come down to see Joram.

17 And the watchman went up on the tower in Jezrael and saw the dust cloud of Jou as he approached and said, I see a dust cloud. And Joram said, Take a rider and send him before them, and let him say, Is it peace?

18 And a horse rider went to meet them and said, Thus says the king: Is it peace? And Jou said, What have you to do with peace? Turn behind me. And the watchman reported, saying, The messenger came to them and did not return.

19 And he sent a second horse rider, and he came to him and said, Thus says the king: Is it peace? And Jou said, What have you to do with peace? Turn behind me.

20 And the watchman reported, saying, He came to them and did not return; and the driver drives like Jou son of Namessi, for it has become a deviation.

21 And Joram said, Harness. And he harnessed a chariot. And Joram king of Israel and Ochozias king of Judah went out, each in his chariot, and went out to meet Jou and found him in the portion of Nabouthai the Jezraelite.

22 And it happened when Joram saw Jou that he said, Is it peace, Jou? And Jou said, What peace, while the prostitutions of Jezabel your mother and her many sorceries remain?

23 And Joram turned his hands to flee and said to Ochozias, Treachery, Ochozias.

24 And Jou filled his hand with the bow and struck Joram between his arms, and the arrow went out through his heart, and he sank upon his knees.

25 And Jou said to Badekar his officer, Throw him into the portion of the field of Nabouthai the Jezraelite; for I remember, you and I riding in teams behind Achaab his father, and the Lord laid this pronouncement upon him, saying,

26 Surely I saw yesterday the blood of Nabouthai and the blood of his sons, says the Lord, and I shall repay him in this portion, says the Lord. And now lift him, please, and throw him into the portion according to the word of the Lord.

27 And Ochozias king of Judah saw and fled by the road of Baithaggan, and Jou pursued after him and said, Him too! And he struck him in the chariot on the ascent to Gai, which is Jeblaam, and he fled to Mageddon and died there.

28 And his servants put him on the chariot and brought him to Jerusalem and buried him in his tomb in the city of David.

29 And in the eleventh year of Joram king of Israel, Ochozias reigned over Judah.

30 And Jou came to Jezrael; and Jezabel heard and painted her eyes and adorned her head and looked out through the window.

31 And Jou was entering the city, and she said, Is it peace, Zambri, murderer of his master?

32 And he lifted his face toward the window and saw her and said, Who are you? Come down with me. And two eunuchs leaned out toward him;

33 and he said, Roll her down. And they rolled her down, and some of her blood was spattered on the wall and on the horses, and they trampled her.

34 And Jou went in and ate and drank and said, Attend to this cursed woman, please, and bury her, for she is a king's daughter.

35 And they went to bury her and found nothing of her except the skull and the feet and the traces of the hands.

36 And they returned and told him, and he said, It is the word of the Lord that he spoke by the hand of his servant Eliou the Thesbite, saying, In the portion of Jezrael the dogs shall devour the flesh of Jezabel,

37 and the corpse of Jezabel shall be like dung on the face of the field in the portion of Jezrael, so that they cannot say, Jezabel.

Chapter 10

1 And Achaab had seventy sons in Samaria. And Jou wrote a letter and sent it into Samaria to the rulers of Samaria and to the elders and to the guardians of Achaab's sons, saying,

2 And now when this letter comes to you, your master's sons are with you, and chariot and horses and fortified cities and weapons are with you;

3 see the good and upright one among your master's sons and set him on his father's throne and fight for your master's house.

4 And they were greatly afraid and said, Behold, the two kings did not stand before him, and how shall we stand?

5 And those over the house and those over the city and the elders and the guardians sent to Jou, saying, We are your servants, and whatever you say to us we shall do; we shall make no man king; we shall do what is good in your eyes.

6 And he wrote a second letter to them, saying, If you are for me and listen to my voice, take the heads of the men, your master's sons, and bring them to me at this time tomorrow in Jezrael. And the king's sons were seventy men; the great men of the city were raising them.

7 And it happened when the letter came to them that they took the king's sons and slaughtered them, seventy men, and put their heads in baskets and sent them to him in Jezrael.

8 And the messenger came and reported, saying, They have brought the heads of the king's sons. And he said, Put them in two heaps by the entrance of the gate until morning.

9 And it happened in the morning that he went out and stood in the gateway of the city and said to all the people, You are righteous. Behold, I conspired against my master and killed him; but who struck all these?

10 See, affo, that none of the word of the Lord that the Lord spoke against the house of Achaab shall fall to the ground; and the Lord has done all that he spoke by the hand of his servant Eliou.

11 And Jou struck all who remained of the house of Achaab in Jezrael and all his great men and his acquaintances and his priests, so as to leave him no remnant.

12 And he arose and went to Samaria. He was at Baithakad of the shepherds on the road,

13 and Jou found the brothers of Ochozias king of Judah and said, Who are you? And they said, We are the brothers of Ochozias, and we have come down for the peace of the king's sons and the sons of the ruling woman.

14 And he said, Seize them alive. And they seized them alive. And they slaughtered them at Baithakad, forty-two men; he left no man of them.

15 And he went from there and found Jonadab son of Rechab on the road to meet him, and he greeted him. And Jou said to him, Is your heart upright with my heart as my heart is with your heart? And Jonadab said, It is. And Jou said, If it is, give me your hand. And he gave his hand, and he brought him up to him upon the chariot

16 and said to him, Come with me and see me in my zeal for the Lord Sabaoth. And he seated him in his chariot.

17 And he entered Samaria and struck all who remained of Achaab in Samaria until he had destroyed him, according to the word of the Lord that he spoke to Eliou.

18 And Jou gathered all the people and said to them, Achaab served Baal a little, but Jou will serve him much;

19 and now call to me all the prophets of Baal, all his servants and his priests; let no man be missing, for I have a great sacrifice for Baal; anyone missing shall not live. And Jou acted with deceit, in order to destroy the servants of Baal.

20 And Jou said, Consecrate a sacrifice for Baal. And they proclaimed it.

21 And Jou sent throughout all Israel, saying, And now all the servants of Baal and all his priests and all his prophets, let none be left out, for I am making a great sacrifice; anyone left out shall not live. And all Baal's servants and all his priests and all his prophets came; not a man was left who did not come. And they entered the house of Baal, and the house of Baal was filled from end to end.

22 And Jou said to the one over the house of mesthaal, Bring out garments for all Baal's servants. And the keeper of garments brought them out for them.

23 And Jou and Jonadab son of Rechab entered the house of Baal and said to Baal's servants, Search and see whether any of the Lord's servants are among you, but only Baal's servants alone.

24 And he entered to perform the sacrifices and the whole burnt offerings. And Jou stationed for himself eighty men outside and said, Any man who escapes from the men whom I bring into your hands, his life shall be in place of his life.

25 And it happened when he finished performing the whole burnt offering that Jou said to the runners and the officers, Enter and strike them; let no man come out from among them. And they struck them with the edge of the sword, and the runners and the officers threw them down and went as far as the city of the house of Baal.

26 And they brought out the pillar of Baal and burned it.

27 And they pulled down the pillars of Baal and demolished the house of Baal and made it into latrines until this day.

28 And Jou destroyed Baal from Israel;

29 but Jou did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin: the golden heifers in Bethel and in Dan.

30 And the Lord said to Jou, Because you did well to do what was right in my eyes and did to the house of Achaab all that was in my heart, sons to the fourth generation shall sit for you on the throne of Israel.

31 And Jou did not take care to walk in the law of the Lord God of Israel with all his heart; he did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

32 In those days the Lord began to cut Israel down, and Azael struck them throughout all the territory of Israel,

33 from the Jordan toward the rising of the sun, all the land of Galaad of Gad and Reuben and Manasseh, from Aroer, which is on the bank of the torrent Arnon, and Galaad and Basan.

34 And the rest of the deeds of Jou and all that he did and all his acts of power and the alliances that he made, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

35 And Jou slept with his fathers, and they buried him in Samaria; and Joachas his son reigned in his stead.

36 And the days that Jou reigned over Israel were twenty-eight years in Samaria.

Chapter 11

1 And Gotholia the mother of Ochozias saw that her sons had died, and she destroyed all the seed of the kingdom.

2 And Josabee daughter of King Joram, sister of Ochozias, took Joas the son of her brother and stole him from among the king's sons who were being put to death, him and his nurse, in the storeroom of the beds; and she hid him from Gotholia, and he was not put to death.

3 And he was hidden with her in the house of the Lord for six years, while Gotholia reigned over the land.

4 And in the seventh year Jodae the priest sent and took the captains of hundreds, Chorri and Rasim, and brought them to him into the house of the Lord and made with them a covenant of the Lord and put them under oath before the Lord; and Jodae showed them the king's son

5 and commanded them, saying, This is the thing that you shall do: let a third of you come in on the sabbath and keep guard of the king's house in the gateway,

6 and a third at the gate of the roads and a third at the gate behind the runners; and you shall keep guard of the house;

7 and two divisions among you, everyone going out on the sabbath, shall keep guard of the house of the Lord for the king;

8 and surround the king all around, each man with his equipment in his hand, and whoever enters the saderoth shall die. And be with the king when he goes out and when he comes in.

9 And the captains of hundreds did all that Jodae the wise commanded, and each man took his men who came in on the sabbath with those who went out on the sabbath and came to Jodae the priest.

10 And the priest gave the captains of hundreds the seiromastai and the trissoi of King David that were in the house of the Lord.

11 And the runners stood, each with his equipment in his hand, from the shoulder of the house on the right to the shoulder of the house on the left of the altar and the house, all around the king.

12 And he brought out the king's son and put upon him the nezer and the testimony and made him king and anointed him, and they clapped their hands and said, Let the king live.

13 And Gotholia heard the sound of the people running and came in to the people in the house of the Lord.

14 And she saw, and behold, the king stood by the pillar according to the custom, and the singers and the trumpets were beside the king, and all the people of the land were rejoicing and sounding trumpets; and Gotholia tore her garments and cried out, Conspiracy, conspiracy.

15 And Jodae the priest commanded the captains of hundreds, the overseers of the force, and said to them, Bring her out within the saderoth, and whoever enters after her shall surely be put to death by the sword; for the priest said, Let her not die in the house of the Lord.

16 And they laid hands on her, and she entered by the road of the horses' entrance of the king's house and died there.

17 And Jodae made a covenant between the Lord and the king and the people, that they should be a people for the Lord, and between the king and the people.

18 And all the people of the land entered the house of Baal and pulled it down and thoroughly shattered its altars and its images, and they killed Matthan the priest of Baal before the altars, and the priest appointed overseers for the house of the Lord.

19 And he took the captains of hundreds and Chorri and Rasim and all the people of the land, and they brought the king down from the house of the Lord, and he entered by the road of the gate of the runners of the king's house, and they seated him upon the throne of the kings.

20 And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet; and they put Gotholia to death with the sword in the king's house.

Chapter 12

1 Joas was a son of seven years when he began to reign.

2 In the seventh year of Jou, Joas reigned, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Abia from Bersabee.

3 And Joas did what was right before the Lord all the days in which Jodae the priest enlightened him;

4 but the high places were not removed, and the people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places there.

5 And Joas said to the priests, All the silver of the holy things that is brought into the house of the Lord, silver of assessment, each man's silver received for assessment, all the silver that comes into a man's heart to bring into the house of the Lord,

6 let the priests take for themselves, each from his sale, and they themselves shall strengthen the bedek of the house wherever bedek is found there.

7 And it happened in the twenty-third year of King Joas that the priests had not strengthened the bedek of the house.

8 And King Joas called Jodae the priest and the priests and said to them, Why do you not strengthen the bedek of the house? And now do not take silver from your sales, for you shall give it for the bedek of the house.

9 And the priests agreed not to take silver from the people and not to strengthen the bedek of the house.

10 And Jodae the priest took one chest and bored a hole in its board and placed it beside iamibin in the house of the man of the house of the Lord, and the priests who kept the station gave all the silver found in the house of the Lord.

11 And it happened when they saw that there was much silver in the chest that the king's scribe and the high priest went up and tied up and counted the silver found in the house of the Lord.

12 And they gave the prepared silver into the hands of those doing the work of the overseers of the house of the Lord, and they paid it out to the woodworkers and to the builders working in the house of the Lord

13 and to the wall builders and to the stonecutters to buy wood and hewn stones to attend to the bedek of the house of the Lord in all that was spent on the house to strengthen it;

14 but silver doors, nails, bowls and trumpets, any gold vessel or silver vessel, were not made for the house of the Lord from the silver brought into the house of the Lord,

15 for they gave it to those doing the work, and with it they strengthened the house of the Lord.

16 And they did not reckon with the men into whose hands they gave the silver to give to those doing the work, for they acted faithfully.

17 Silver for sin and silver for wrongdoing, whatever was brought into the house of the Lord, belonged to the priests.

18 Then Azael king of Syria went up and fought against Geth and took it first. And Azael set his face to go up against Jerusalem.

19 And Joas king of Judah took all the holy things that Josaphat and Joram and Ochozias, his fathers and kings of Judah, had consecrated, and his own holy things and all the gold found in the treasuries of the house of the Lord and the king's house, and sent them to Azael king of Syria, and he went up from Jerusalem.

20 And the rest of the deeds of Joas and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

21 And his servants arose and bound every conspiracy and struck Joas in the house of Mallo in Gaalla.

22 And Jezechar son of Jemouath and Jezebouth his son Somer, his servants, struck him, and he died; and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David, and Amessias his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 13

1 In the twenty-third year of Joas son of Ochozias king of Judah, Joachas son of Jou reigned in Samaria for seventeen years.

2 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord and followed the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin; he did not depart from them.

3 And the Lord was angry with wrath against Israel and gave them into the hand of Azael king of Syria and into the hand of the son of Ader son of Azael all the days.

4 And Joachas entreated the face of the Lord, and the Lord heard him, for he saw the affliction of Israel, for the king of Syria oppressed them.

5 And the Lord gave deliverance to Israel, and it went out from under the hand of Syria, and the sons of Israel dwelt in their tents as yesterday and the day before;

6 but they did not depart from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, who caused Israel to sin; in them they walked, and indeed the grove remained standing in Samaria.

7 For no people were left to Joachas except fifty horsemen and ten chariots and ten thousand foot soldiers, for the king of Syria had destroyed them and made them like dust for trampling.

8 And the rest of the deeds of Joachas and all that he did and his acts of power, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

9 And Joachas slept with his fathers, and they buried him with his fathers in Samaria, and Joas his son reigned in his stead.

10 In the thirty-seventh year of Joas king of Judah, Joas son of Joachas reigned over Israel in Samaria for sixteen years.

11 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord; he did not depart from any of the sin of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin; in them he walked.

12 And the rest of the deeds of Joas and all that he did and his acts of power that he performed with Amessias king of Judah, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

13 And Joas slept with his fathers, and Jeroboam sat on his throne in Samaria with the sons of Israel.

14 And Elisaie became ill with the illness from which he died. And Joas king of Israel came down to him and wept upon his face and said, Father, father, chariot of Israel and its horseman.

15 And Elisaie said to him, Take a bow and arrows. And he took a bow and arrows to him.

16 And he said to the king, Put your hand upon the bow. And Joas put his hand upon the bow, and Elisaie placed his hands upon the king's hands.

17 And he said, Open the window toward the east. And he opened it. And Elisaie said, Shoot. And he shot. And he said, An arrow of deliverance for the Lord and an arrow of deliverance in Syria, and you shall strike Syria at Aphek until its end.

18 And Elisaie said to him, Take bows. And he took them. And he said to the king of Israel, Strike the ground. And the king struck three times and stopped.

19 And the man of God was grieved over him and said, If you had struck five or six times, then you would have struck Syria until its end; but now you shall strike Syria three times.

20 And Elisaie died, and they buried him. And bands of Moab came into the land at the coming of the year;

21 and it happened as they were burying a man that, behold, they saw the band and threw the man into Elisaie's tomb, and he went and touched Elisaie's bones and lived and stood upon his feet.

22 And Azael oppressed Israel all the days of Joachas.

23 And the Lord had mercy on them and pitied them and looked toward them because of his covenant with Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, and the Lord did not wish to destroy them and did not cast them away from his face.

24 And Azael king of Syria died, and the son of Ader his son reigned in his stead.

25 And Joas son of Joachas returned and took the cities from the hand of the son of Ader son of Azael, which he had taken from the hand of Joachas his father in war; three times Joas struck him and restored the cities of Israel.

Chapter 14

1 In the second year of Joas son of Joachas king of Israel, Amessias son of Joas reigned as king of Judah.

2 He was a son of twenty-five years when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Joadin from Jerusalem.

3 And he did what was right in the eyes of the Lord, though not like David his father; he did according to all that Joas his father had done;

4 but he did not remove the high places; the people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places.

5 And it happened when the kingdom grew strong in his hand that he struck his servants who had struck his father;

6 but he did not put the sons of those who struck him to death, as it is written in the book of the laws of Moses, as the Lord commanded, saying, Fathers shall not die for sons, and sons shall not die for fathers, but each shall die for his own sins.

7 He struck Edom in Gaimele, ten thousand, and seized Petra in the war and called its name Kathoel until this day.

8 Then Amessias sent messengers to Joas son of Joachas son of Jou king of Israel, saying, Come, let us see each other face to face.

9 And Joas king of Israel sent to Amessias king of Judah, saying, The thorn in Lebanon sent to the cedar in Lebanon, saying, Give your daughter to my son as a wife; and the beasts of the field in Lebanon passed through and trampled the thorn.

10 Striking, you struck Idoumaia, and your heart lifted you up; be glorified while sitting in your house, and why do you strive in your wickedness? You shall fall, you and Judah with you.

11 And Amessias did not listen. And the king of Israel went up, and he and Amessias king of Judah saw each other face to face at Baithsamys of Judah;

12 and Judah stumbled before Israel, and each man fled to his tent;

13 and Joas son of Joachas king of Israel seized Amessias son of Joas son of Ochozias king of Judah at Baithsamys. And he came to Jerusalem and pulled down four hundred cubits of the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate;

14 and he took the gold and the silver and all the vessels found in the house of the Lord and in the treasuries of the king's house and the sons of the minglings and returned to Samaria.

15 And the rest of the deeds of Joas, what he did in his power, how he fought with Amessias king of Judah, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

16 And Joas slept with his fathers and was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel, and Jeroboam his son reigned in his stead.

17 And Amessias son of Joas king of Judah lived fifteen years after the death of Joas son of Joachas king of Israel.

18 And the rest of the deeds of Amessias and all that he did, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

19 And they formed a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem, and he fled to Lachis; and they sent after him to Lachis and put him to death there.

20 And they carried him on horses, and he was buried in Jerusalem with his fathers in the city of David.

21 And all the people of Judah took Azarias, who was a son of sixteen years, and made him king in place of his father Amessias.

22 He built Ailoth and restored it to Judah after the king slept with his fathers.

23 In the fifteenth year of Amessias son of Joas king of Judah, Jeroboam son of Joas reigned over Israel in Samaria for forty-one years.

24 And he did evil before the Lord; he did not depart from all the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

25 He restored the border of Israel from the entrance of Aimath as far as the sea of the Araba, according to the word of the Lord God of Israel that he spoke by the hand of his servant Jona son of Amathi, the prophet from Gethchober.

26 For the Lord saw the humiliation of Israel, very bitter, and the few who were held and those who lacked and those left behind, and there was no one helping Israel.

27 And the Lord had not spoken of wiping out the seed of Israel from under heaven, and he saved them by the hand of Jeroboam son of Joas.

28 And the rest of the deeds of Jeroboam and all that he did and his acts of power, how he fought and how he restored Damascus and Aimath to Judah in Israel, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

29 And Jeroboam slept with his fathers, with the kings of Israel, and Azarias son of Amessias reigned in place of his father.

Chapter 15

1 In the twenty-seventh year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Azarias son of Amessias king of Judah reigned.

2 He was a son of sixteen years when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Chalia from Jerusalem.

3 And he did what was right in the eyes of the Lord according to all that Amessias his father had done;

4 but he did not remove the high places; the people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places.

5 And the Lord touched the king, and he was afflicted with leprosy until the day of his death and reigned in the house of affousoth, and Joatham the king's son was over the house, judging the people of the land.

6 And the rest of the deeds of Azarias and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

7 And Azarias slept with his fathers, and they buried him with his fathers in the city of David, and Joatham his son reigned in his stead.

8 In the thirty-eighth year of Azarias king of Judah, Zacharias son of Jeroboam reigned over Israel in Samaria for six months.

9 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord, as his fathers had done; he did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

10 And Selloum son of Jabis and Keblaam conspired against him and struck him and put him to death, and Selloum reigned in his stead.

11 And the rest of the deeds of Zacharias, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

12 The word of the Lord that he spoke to Jou, saying, Sons to the fourth generation shall sit for you on the throne of Israel; and so it happened.

13 And Selloum son of Jabis reigned; and in the thirty-ninth year of Azarias king of Judah, Selloum reigned for a month of days in Samaria.

14 And Manaem son of Gaddi went up from Tharsila and came to Samaria and struck Selloum son of Jabis in Samaria and put him to death.

15 And the rest of the deeds of Selloum and the conspiracy that he formed, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

16 Then Manaem struck Thersa and all within it and its territories from Thersa, because they did not open to him; and he struck it and tore open its pregnant women.

17 In the thirty-ninth year of Azarias king of Judah, Manaem son of Gaddi reigned over Israel for ten years in Samaria.

18 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord; he did not depart from all the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

19 In his days Phoul king of the Assyrians went up against the land, and Manaem gave Phoul a thousand talents of silver so that his hand would be with him.

20 And Manaem brought out the silver upon Israel, upon every man mighty in strength, to give to the king of the Assyrians, fifty shekels per man; and the king of the Assyrians returned and did not stay there in the land.

21 And the rest of the deeds of Manaem and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?

22 And Manaem slept with his fathers, and Phakeias his son reigned in his stead.

23 In the fiftieth year of Azarias king of Judah, Phakeias son of Manaem reigned over Israel in Samaria for two years.

24 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord; he did not depart from the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

25 And Phakee son of Romeliou his officer conspired against him and struck him in Samaria before the king's house, with Argob and Aria, and with him fifty men of the four hundred; and he put him to death and reigned in his stead.

26 And the rest of the deeds of Phakeias and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

27 In the fifty-second year of Azarias king of Judah, Phakee son of Romeliou reigned over Israel in Samaria for twenty years.

28 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord; he did not depart from all the sins of Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin.

29 In the days of Phakee king of Israel, Thaglathphellasar king of the Assyrians came and took Ain and Abelbaithamaacha and Janoch and Kenez and Asor and Galaad and Galilaia, all the land of Nephthali, and deported them to the Assyrians.

30 And Osee son of Ela formed a conspiracy against Phakee son of Romeliou and struck him and put him to death and reigned in his stead in the twentieth year of Joatham son of Azarias.

31 And the rest of the deeds of Phakee and all that he did, behold, they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.

32 In the second year of Phakee son of Romeliou king of Israel, Joatham son of Azarias king of Judah reigned.

33 He was a son of twenty-five years when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Jerousa daughter of Sadok.

34 And he did what was right in the eyes of the Lord according to all that Ozias his father had done;

35 but he did not remove the high places; the people still sacrificed and burned incense on the high places. He built the upper gate of the house of the Lord.

36 And the rest of the deeds of Joatham and all that he did, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

37 In those days the Lord began to send against Judah Raasson king of Syria and Phakee son of Romeliou.

38 And Joatham slept with his fathers and was buried with his fathers in the city of David his father, and Achaz his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 16

1 In the seventeenth year of Phakee son of Romeliou, Achaz son of Joatham king of Judah reigned.

2 Achaz was a son of twenty years when he began to reign, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem. And he did not faithfully do what was right in the eyes of the Lord his God as David his father had done,

3 and he walked in the way of Jeroboam son of Nabat king of Israel and even made his son pass through fire according to the abominations of the nations whom the Lord had removed before the sons of Israel,

4 and he sacrificed and burned incense on the high places and on the hills and under every wooded tree.

5 Then Raasson king of Syria and Phakee son of Romeliou king of Israel went up to Jerusalem for war and besieged Achaz, but they were unable to fight.

6 At that time Raasson king of Syria restored Ailath to Syria and drove the Judeans out of Ailath, and Idoumaians came to Ailath and lived there until this day.

7 And Achaz sent messengers to Thaglathphellasar king of the Assyrians, saying, I am your servant and your son; come up and save me from the hand of the king of Syria and from the hand of the king of Israel, who are rising against me.

8 And Achaz took the silver and the gold found in the treasuries of the house of the Lord and the king's house and sent gifts to the king.

9 And the king of the Assyrians listened to him, and the king of the Assyrians went up to Damascus and captured it and deported it and put Raasson to death.

10 And King Achaz went to meet Thaglathphellasar king of the Assyrians in Damascus. And he saw the altar in Damascus, and King Achaz sent to Ourias the priest the likeness of the altar and its pattern for all its workmanship;

11 and Ourias the priest built the altar according to all that King Achaz had sent from Damascus.

12 And the king saw the altar and went up upon it

13 and burned his whole burnt offering and his sacrifice and his drink offering and poured the blood of his peace offerings upon the altar.

14 And he brought the bronze altar that was before the Lord from before the house of the Lord, from between the altar and the house of the Lord, and placed it on the north side of the altar.

15 And King Achaz commanded Ourias the priest, saying, On the great altar offer the morning whole burnt offering and the evening sacrifice and the king's whole burnt offering and his sacrifice and the whole burnt offering of all the people and their sacrifice and their drink offering, and pour upon it all blood of a whole burnt offering and all blood of a sacrifice; and the bronze altar shall be for me for the morning.

16 And Ourias the priest did according to all that King Achaz commanded him.

17 And King Achaz cut off the fittings of the mechonoth and removed the basin from them, and took down the sea from the bronze oxen beneath it and put it upon a stone base.

18 And he built the foundation of the seat in the house of the Lord and turned the king's outer entrance in the house of the Lord because of the king of the Assyrians.

19 And the rest of the deeds of Achaz, as many as he did, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

20 And Achaz slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David, and Ezekias his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 17

1 In the twelfth year of Achaz king of Judah, Osee son of Ela reigned in Samaria over Israel for nine years.

2 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord, though not like the kings of Israel who were before him.

3 Salamanasar king of the Assyrians went up against him, and Osee became his servant and rendered manaa to him.

4 And the king of the Assyrians found wrongdoing in Osee, for he had sent messengers to Segor king of Egypt and had not brought manaa to the king of the Assyrians in that year, and the king of the Assyrians besieged him and bound him in a prison house.

5 And the king of the Assyrians went up through all the land and went up to Samaria and besieged it for three years.

6 In the ninth year of Osee, the king of the Assyrians captured Samaria and deported Israel to the Assyrians and settled them in Alae and Abor, rivers of Gozan, and the mountains of the Medes.

7 And it happened because the sons of Israel sinned against the Lord their God, who had brought them up from the land of Egypt from under the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt, and they feared other gods

8 and walked in the ordinances of the nations whom the Lord had removed before the sons of Israel, and in those of the kings of Israel, as many as had made them,

9 and as many as the sons of Israel had clothed themselves with words that were not so against the Lord their God, and they built high places for themselves in all their cities, from a watchmen's tower to a fortified city,

10 and set up for themselves pillars and groves on every high hill and under every wooded tree

11 and burned incense there on all the high places like the nations whom the Lord had deported before them, and they made associates and carved, to provoke the Lord,

12 and served idols, concerning which the Lord had told them, You shall not do this thing to the Lord.

13 And the Lord testified to Israel and Judah by the hand of all his prophets, of every seer, saying, Turn away from your evil ways and keep my commandments and my ordinances and all the law that I commanded your fathers, all that I sent to them by the hand of my servants the prophets.

14 And they did not listen and made their back harder than the back of their fathers,

15 and they did not keep his testimonies with which he testified to them and went after vain things and became vain and after the nations around them, concerning whom he commanded them not to do as they did;

16 they abandoned the commandments of the Lord their God and made for themselves a molten image, two heifers, and made groves and bowed to all the host of heaven and served Baal

17 and made their sons and daughters pass through fire and practiced divinations and took omens and sold themselves to do evil in the eyes of the Lord, to provoke him.

18 And the Lord became very angry with Israel and removed them from before his face, and none remained except the tribe of Judah alone.

19 And even Judah did not keep the commandments of the Lord their God and walked in the ordinances of Israel that they made,

20 and they rejected the Lord among all the seed of Israel, and he shook them and gave them into the hands of those plundering them, until he cast them away from before his face.

21 For Israel departed from the house of David and made Jeroboam son of Nabat king, and Jeroboam drove Israel away from following the Lord and caused them to sin a great sin;

22 and the sons of Israel walked in all the sin of Jeroboam that he committed; they did not depart from it,

23 until the Lord removed Israel from before his face, as the Lord had spoken by the hand of all his servants the prophets, and Israel was deported from its land to the Assyrians until this day.

24 And the king of the Assyrians brought from Babylon the one from Chountha and from Aia and from Aimath and Seppharouain, and they were settled in the cities of Samaria in place of the sons of Israel and inherited Samaria and dwelt in its cities.

25 And it happened at the beginning of their dwelling there that they did not fear the Lord, and the Lord sent lions among them, and they were killing among them.

26 And they said to the king of the Assyrians, saying, The nations that you deported and settled in the cities of Samaria do not know the judgment of the God of the land, and he sent lions among them, and behold, they are killing them because they do not know the judgment of the God of the land.

27 And the king of the Assyrians commanded, saying, Bring them from there, and let them go and dwell there, and they shall teach them the judgment of the God of the land.

28 And they brought one of the priests whom they had deported from Samaria, and he dwelt in Bethel and was teaching them how to fear the Lord.

29 And the nations made, each nation, their gods and put them in the house of the high places that the Samaritans had made, each nation in its cities where they dwelt;

30 and the men of Babylon made Sokchothbainith, and the men of Chouth made Nerigel, and the men of Aimath made Asimath,

31 and the Euaioi made Eblazer and Tharthak, and the Seppharouain burned their sons in fire to Adramelech and Anemelech, gods of Seppharouain.

32 And they feared the Lord and settled their abominations in the houses of the high places that they had made in Samaria, each nation in the city in which it dwelt; and they feared the Lord and made for themselves priests of the high places and made for themselves in the house of the high places.

33 They feared the Lord and served their gods according to the custom of the nations from which he had deported them.

34 Until this day they did according to their custom; they fear and they act according to their ordinances and according to their judgment and according to the law and according to the commandment that the Lord commanded the sons of Jacob, whom he named Israel,

35 and the Lord made a covenant with them and commanded them, saying, You shall not fear other gods and shall not bow to them and shall not serve them and shall not sacrifice to them,

36 but the Lord who brought you up from the land of Egypt with great strength and an uplifted arm, him you shall fear and to him you shall bow and to him you shall sacrifice;

37 and the ordinances and the judgments and the law and the commandments that he wrote for you, you shall take care to do all the days, and you shall not fear other gods;

38 and the covenant that he made with you, you shall not forget, and you shall not fear other gods,

39 but you shall fear the Lord your God, and he will deliver you from all your enemies;

40 and you shall not listen regarding their custom that they perform.

41 And these nations feared the Lord and served their carved images, and indeed their sons and their sons' sons do as their fathers did until this day.

Chapter 18

1 And it happened in the third year of Osee son of Ela king of Israel that Ezekias son of Achaz king of Judah reigned.

2 He was a son of twenty-five years when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Abou daughter of Zacharias.

3 And he did what was right in the eyes of the Lord according to all that David his father had done.

4 He removed the high places and crushed all the pillars and destroyed the groves and the bronze serpent that Moses had made, for until those days the sons of Israel had been burning incense to it, and he called it Neesthan.

5 He hoped in the Lord God of Israel, and after him no one like him arose among the kings of Judah or among those who were before him;

6 and he clung to the Lord, did not depart from following him, and kept his commandments, as many as he had commanded Moses;

7 and the Lord was with him; in all that he did he understood. And he rebelled against the king of the Assyrians and did not serve him.

8 He struck the foreigners as far as Gaza and its border, from a watchmen's tower as far as a fortified city.

9 And it happened in the fourth year of King Ezekias [the same year was the seventh of Osee son of Ela king of Israel] that Salamanassar king of the Assyrians went up against Samaria and besieged it;

10 and he took it at the end of three years, in the sixth year of Ezekias [the same year was the ninth of Osee king of Israel], and Samaria was captured.

11 And the king of the Assyrians deported Samaria to the Assyrians and placed them in Alae and Abor by the river Gozan and the mountains of the Medes,

12 because they had not listened to the voice of the Lord their God and had transgressed his covenant, all that Moses the servant of the Lord had commanded; and they neither listened nor did it.

13 And in the fourteenth year of King Ezekias, Sennacherim king of the Assyrians went up against the fortified cities of Judah and seized them.

14 And Ezekias king of Judah sent messengers to the king of the Assyrians at Lachis, saying, I have sinned; turn away from me; whatever you place upon me I shall bear. And the king of the Assyrians placed upon Ezekias king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents of gold.

15 And Ezekias gave all the silver found in the house of the Lord and in the treasuries of the king's house.

16 At that time Ezekias cut off the doors of the temple of the Lord and the supports that Ezekias king of Judah had gilded, and gave them to the king of the Assyrians.

17 And the king of the Assyrians sent Tharthan and Raphis and Rapsakes from Lachis to King Ezekias with a heavy force against Jerusalem, and they went up and came to Jerusalem and stood by the aqueduct of the upper pool, which is on the road of the fuller's field.

18 And they called to Ezekias, and Eliakim son of Chelkias the steward and Somnas the scribe and Joas son of Asaph the recorder came out to him.

19 And Rapsakes said to them, Say, please, to Ezekias: Thus says the great king, king of the Assyrians: What is this trust in which you have trusted?

20 You said, Mere words of lips are counsel and strength for war. Now in whom have you trusted, that you have rebelled against me?

21 Now behold, you have trusted yourself to this broken reed staff, Egypt; if a man leans upon it, it will enter his hand and pierce it; so is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust in him.

22 And if you say to me, We have trusted in the Lord God, is he not the one whose high places and altars Ezekias removed and said to Judah and Jerusalem, Before this altar you shall worship in Jerusalem?

23 And now make an agreement, please, with my master the king of the Assyrians, and I shall give you two thousand horses if you can provide riders for yourself upon them.

24 And how will you turn away the face of one district governor among the least of my master's servants? And you have trusted yourself to Egypt for chariots and horsemen.

25 And now did we come up against this place to destroy it without the Lord? The Lord said to me, Go up against this land and destroy it.

26 And Eliakim son of Chelkias and Somnas and Joas said to Rapsakes, Speak, please, to your servants in Syrian, for we understand, and do not speak with us in Judean; why speak in the ears of the people on the wall?

27 And Rapsakes said to them, Did my master send me to speak these words to your master and you? Was it not to the men sitting on the wall, to eat their dung and drink their urine together with you?

28 And Rapsakes stood and cried out in a great voice in Judean and spoke and said, Hear the words of the great king of the Assyrians:

29 Thus says the king: Let Ezekias not lift you up with words, for he shall certainly not be able to deliver you from my hand.

30 And let Ezekias not make you hope in the Lord, saying, The Lord will surely deliver us, and this city shall certainly not be given into the hand of the king of the Assyrians.

31 Do not listen to Ezekias, for thus says the king of the Assyrians: Make a blessing with me and come out to me, and each man shall drink from his vine and each man shall eat from his fig tree and drink water from his cistern,

32 until I come and take you to a land like your land, a land of grain and wine and bread and vineyards, a land of olive oil and honey, and you shall live and certainly not die. And do not listen to Ezekias, for he deceives you, saying, The Lord will rescue us.

33 Have the gods of the nations surely rescued, each his own country, from the hand of the king of the Assyrians?

34 Where is the god of Aimath and Arphad? Where is the god of Seppharouain? And did they deliver Samaria from my hand?

35 Who among all the gods of the lands delivered their lands from my hand, that the Lord should deliver Jerusalem from my hand?

36 And they were silent and did not answer him a word, for it was the king's command, saying, You shall not answer him.

37 And Eliakim son of Chelkias the steward and Somnas the scribe and Joas son of Asaph the recorder came to Ezekias with their garments torn and reported to him the words of Rapsakes.

Chapter 19

1 And it happened when King Ezekias heard that he tore his garments and put on sackcloth and entered the house of the Lord.

2 And he sent Eliakim the steward and Somnas the scribe and the elders of the priests, clothed in sackcloth, to Esaias the prophet son of Amos,

3 and they said to him, Thus says Ezekias: This day is a day of affliction and rebuke and provocation, for sons have come to the pangs of birth, but the woman giving birth has no strength;

4 perhaps the Lord your God will hear all the words of Rapsakes, whom the king of the Assyrians his master sent to reproach the living God and blaspheme with words that the Lord your God has heard, and you will offer a prayer for the remnant that is found.

5 And the servants of King Ezekias came to Esaias,

6 and Esaias said to them, Thus shall you say to your master: Thus says the Lord: Do not fear because of the words you have heard, with which the servants of the king of the Assyrians blasphemed;

7 behold, I put a spirit in him, and he shall hear a report and return to his land, and I shall bring him down by the sword in his land.

8 And Rapsakes returned and found the king of the Assyrians fighting against Lomna, for he had heard that he had departed from Lachis;

9 and he heard concerning Tharaka king of the Ethiopians, saying, Behold, he has gone out to fight against you. And he returned and sent messengers to Ezekias, saying,

10 Let your God in whom you trust not lift you up, saying, Jerusalem shall certainly not be given into the hands of the king of the Assyrians.

11 Behold, you have heard all that the kings of the Assyrians did to all the lands, to devote them to destruction; and will you be delivered?

12 Did the gods of the nations whom my fathers destroyed deliver them, Gozan and Charran and Raphes and the sons of Edem who are in Thaesthen?

13 Where is the king of Aimath and the king of Arphad? And where are Seppharouain, Ana and Aua?

14 And Ezekias took the letters from the hands of the messengers and read them; and he went up to the house of the Lord, and Ezekias spread them out before the Lord

15 and said, Lord God of Israel, who sits upon the cherubim, you alone are God in all the kingdoms of the earth; you made heaven and earth.

16 Incline your ear, Lord, and hear; open your eyes, Lord, and see, and hear the words of Sennacherim that he sent to reproach the living God.

17 For truly, Lord, the kings of the Assyrians have laid waste the nations

18 and have given their gods to the fire, for they are not gods but works of human hands, wood and stone, and they destroyed them.

19 And now, Lord our God, save us from his hand, and all the kingdoms of the earth shall know that you alone are the Lord God.

20 And Esaias son of Amos sent to Ezekias, saying, Thus says the Lord God of hosts, the God of Israel: I have heard what you prayed to me concerning Sennacherim king of the Assyrians.

21 This is the word that the Lord spoke against him: Virgin daughter Zion has despised and mocked you; daughter Jerusalem has shaken her head at you.

22 Whom did you reproach and blaspheme? And against whom did you lift your voice? And you raised your eyes on high against the Holy One of Israel.

23 By the hand of your messengers you reproached the Lord and said, With the multitude of my chariots I shall ascend to the height of the mountains, the flanks of Lebanon, and I cut down the greatness of its cedar, its choice cypresses, and came to the melon of its end, the forest of its Carmel.

24 I cooled and drank foreign waters and dried up with the sole of my foot all the rivers of the enclosure.

25 I formed it; now I have brought it about, and it became for the raising up of colonies of warriors, fortified cities.

26 And those dwelling in them were weak of hand, were terrified and ashamed; they became grass of the field or green herbage, grass of rooftops and a thing trampled before one standing.

27 And I have known your sitting and your going out and your coming in and your anger against me.

28 Because of your anger against me and your arrogance that rose into my ears, I shall put my hooks in your nostrils and a bridle in your lips and turn you back on the road by which you came.

29 And this shall be the sign for you: this year you shall eat what grows of itself and in the second year what springs up; and in the third, sowing and harvest and planting of vineyards, and you shall eat their fruit.

30 And the surviving remnant of the house of Judah shall again put a root below and make fruit above.

31 For a remnant shall go out from Jerusalem and one escaping from Mount Zion; the zeal of the Lord of hosts shall do this.

32 Not so; thus says the Lord concerning the king of the Assyrians: He shall not enter this city and shall not shoot an arrow there, and no shield shall come before it, and he shall certainly not throw up a siege mound against it;

33 by the road by which he came he shall return, and into this city he shall not enter, says the Lord.

34 And I shall defend this city for my own sake and for the sake of David my servant.

35 And it happened by night that an angel of the Lord went out and struck a hundred and eighty-five thousand in the camp of the Assyrians; and they arose early in the morning, and behold, all were dead bodies.

36 And Sennacherim king of the Assyrians departed and went and returned and dwelt in Nineveh.

37 And it happened while he was worshiping in the house of Nesserach his god that Adramelech and Sarasar his sons struck him with a sword, and they escaped to the land of Ararat; and Asordan his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 20

1 In those days Ezekias became ill to the point of death. And Esaias son of Amos the prophet came in to him and said to him, Thus says the Lord: Give instructions to your house, for you are dying and shall not live.

2 And Ezekias turned his face to the wall and prayed to the Lord, saying,

3 Oh Lord, remember, please, how I walked before you in truth and with a full heart and did what was good in your eyes. And Ezekias wept with great weeping.

4 And Esaias was in the middle court, and the word of the Lord came to him, saying,

5 Return and say to Ezekias the leader of my people, Thus says the Lord God of David your father: I have heard your prayer, I have seen your tears; behold, I shall heal you; on the third day you shall go up to the house of the Lord,

6 and I shall add fifteen years to your days, and I shall save you and this city from the hand of the king of the Assyrians, and I shall defend this city for my own sake and for David my servant.

7 And he said, Let them take a cake of figs and put it on the sore, and he shall recover.

8 And Ezekias said to Esaias, What is the sign that the Lord will heal me and I shall go up to the house of the Lord on the third day?

9 And Esaias said, This is the sign from the Lord that the Lord will do the word he spoke: shall the shadow go ten steps, or return ten steps?

10 And Ezekias said, It is a light thing for the shadow to incline ten steps; no, but let the shadow return ten steps backward.

11 And Esaias the prophet cried out to the Lord, and the shadow returned backward on the steps ten steps.

12 At that time Marodachbaladan son of Baladan king of Babylon sent letters and manaa to Ezekias, for he heard that Ezekias had become ill.

13 And Ezekias rejoiced over them and showed them the whole house of the nechotha, the silver and the gold, the spices and the good oil, and the house of the vessels and all that was found in his treasuries; there was not a thing that Ezekias did not show them in his house and in all his dominion.

14 And Esaias the prophet entered to King Ezekias and said to him, What did these men say, and from where have they come to you? And Ezekias said, They have come to me from a distant land, from Babylon.

15 And he said, What did they see in your house? And he said, They saw all that is in my house; there was nothing in my house that I did not show them, including what is in my treasuries.

16 And Esaias said to Ezekias, Hear the word of the Lord:

17 Behold, days are coming, and all that is in your house and what your fathers stored up until this day shall be taken to Babylon; and not a thing shall remain, as the Lord said;

18 and your sons who will come forth from you, whom you shall beget, he shall take, and they shall be eunuchs in the house of the king of Babylon.

19 And Ezekias said to Esaias, Good is the word of the Lord that he spoke; let there be peace in my days.

20 And the rest of the deeds of Ezekias and all his acts of power and all that he did, the spring and the aqueduct and how he brought the water into the city, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

21 And Ezekias slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David, and Manasses his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 21

1 Manasses was a son of twelve years when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Opsiba.

2 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord according to the abominations of the nations whom the Lord had removed before the sons of Israel,

3 and he turned and built the high places that Ezekias his father had pulled down and raised an altar for Baal and made groves, as Achaab king of Israel had done, and bowed to all the host of heaven and served them,

4 and built an altar in the house of the Lord, as he said, In Jerusalem I shall put my name,

5 and built an altar to all the host of heaven in the two courts of the house of the Lord,

6 and made his sons pass through fire and practiced omens and divination and made a consulter and knowers; he multiplied doing evil in the eyes of the Lord to provoke him.

7 And he put the carved image of the grove in the house of which the Lord had said to David and to Salomon his son, In this house and in Jerusalem, which I chose from all the tribes of Israel, I shall put my name there forever,

8 and I shall no longer shake the foot of Israel from the land that I gave their fathers, if they keep all that I commanded according to the whole commandment that my servant Moses commanded them.

9 And they did not listen, and Manasses led them astray to do evil in the eyes of the Lord beyond the nations whom the Lord had destroyed before the sons of Israel.

10 And the Lord spoke by the hand of his servants the prophets, saying,

11 Because Manasses king of Judah did these evil abominations beyond all that the Amorite before him had done, and even caused Judah to sin with their idols,

12 therefore thus says the Lord God of Israel: Behold, I bring evils upon Jerusalem and Judah so that both ears of everyone hearing shall ring,

13 and I shall stretch over Jerusalem the measure of Samaria and the plumb line of the house of Achaab and wipe away Jerusalem as an alabaster vessel is wiped and turned over on its face,

14 and I shall reject the remnant of my inheritance and give them into the hands of their enemies, and they shall be for plunder and for spoil to all their enemies,

15 because they did evil in my eyes and have been provoking me from the day I brought their fathers out of Egypt until this day.

16 And indeed Manasses poured out very much innocent blood until he filled Jerusalem from end to end, besides his sins by which he caused Judah to sin, doing evil in the eyes of the Lord.

17 And the rest of the deeds of Manasses and all that he did and the sin that he sinned, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

18 And Manasses slept with his fathers and was buried in the garden of his house, in the garden of Oza, and Amon his son reigned in his stead.

19 Amon was a son of twenty-two years when he began to reign, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Mesollam daughter of Arous from Jeteba.

20 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord, as Manasses his father had done,

21 and walked in all the way in which his father had walked and served the idols that his father had served and bowed to them

22 and abandoned the Lord God of his fathers and did not walk in the way of the Lord.

23 And the servants of Amon conspired against him and put the king to death in his house.

24 And all the people of the land struck all those who had conspired against King Amon, and the people of the land made Josias his son king in his stead.

25 And the rest of the deeds of Amon, as many as he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

26 And they buried him in his tomb in the garden of Oza, and Josias his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 22

1 Josias was a son of eight years when he began to reign, and he reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Jedida daughter of Edeia from Basouroth.

2 And he did what was right in the eyes of the Lord and walked in all the way of David his father; he did not depart to the right or the left.

3 And it happened in the eighteenth year of King Josias, in the eighth month, that the king sent Saphphan son of Eseliou son of Mesollam, the scribe of the house of the Lord, saying,

4 Go up to Chelkias the high priest and seal the silver brought into the house of the Lord, which those keeping the station gathered from the people,

5 and let them give it into the hands of the workers appointed in the house of the Lord. And he gave it to the workers in the house of the Lord to strengthen the bedek of the house,

6 to the craftsmen and the builders and the wall builders, and to buy wood and hewn stones to strengthen the bedek of the house;

7 but they did not reckon the silver given to them with them, for they acted faithfully.

8 And Chelkias the high priest said to Saphphan the scribe, I found a book of the law in the house of the Lord. And Chelkias gave the book to Saphphan, and he read it.

9 And he brought it to King Josias and returned a word to the king and said, Your servants have melted down the silver found in the house of the Lord and given it into the hands of the workers appointed in the house of the Lord.

10 And Saphphan the scribe spoke to the king, saying, Chelkias the priest gave me a book. And Saphphan read it before the king.

11 And it happened when the king heard the words of the book of the law that he tore his garments.

12 And the king commanded Chelkias the priest and Achikam son of Saphphan and Achobor son of Michaiou and Saphphan the scribe and Asaia the king's servant, saying,

13 Go, seek the Lord concerning me and all the people and all Judah concerning the words of this book that was found, for great is the wrath of the Lord kindled among us because our fathers did not listen to the words of this book to do according to all that is written against us.

14 And Chelkias the priest and Achikam and Achobor and Saphphan and Asaias went to Olda the prophetess, wife of Sellem son of Thekoue son of Araas the keeper of garments; and she dwelt in Jerusalem in the masena, and they spoke to her.

15 And she said to them, Thus says the Lord God of Israel: Say to the man who sent you to me,

16 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am bringing evils upon this place and its inhabitants, all the words of the book that the king of Judah read,

17 because they abandoned me and burned incense to other gods so as to provoke me with the works of their hands; and my anger shall be kindled against this place and shall not be quenched.

18 And to the king of Judah who sent you to seek the Lord, thus shall you say to him: Thus says the Lord God of Israel: The words that you heard,

19 because your heart was softened and you were humbled before the Lord when you heard what I spoke against this place and its inhabitants, that it should become a desolation and a curse, and you tore your garments and wept before me, I too have heard, says the Lord.

20 Therefore behold, I am adding you to your fathers, and you shall be gathered to your tomb in peace, and your eyes shall not see all the evils that I am bringing upon this place. And they returned the word to the king.

Chapter 23

1 And the king sent and gathered to himself all the elders of Judah and Jerusalem.

2 And the king went up to the house of the Lord, and every man of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem with him, and the priests and the prophets and all the people from small to great; and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant found in the house of the Lord.

3 And the king stood by the pillar and made a covenant before the Lord to walk after the Lord and to keep his commandments and his testimonies and his ordinances with all his heart and all his soul, to establish the words of this covenant written in this book; and all the people stood in the covenant.

4 And the king commanded Chelkias the high priest and the priests of the second order and those keeping the station to bring out from the temple of the Lord all the vessels made for Baal and for the grove and for all the host of heaven, and he burned them outside Jerusalem in the sademoth of Kedron and carried their dust to Bethel.

5 And he put an end to the chomarim whom the kings of Judah had appointed, who burned incense at the high places and in the cities of Judah and around Jerusalem, and those burning incense to Baal and the sun and the moon and the mazouroth and all the host of heaven.

6 And he brought the grove out of the house of the Lord outside Jerusalem to the torrent Kedron and burned it in the torrent Kedron and ground it to dust and threw its dust into the grave of the sons of the people.

7 And he demolished the house of the kadesim in the house of the Lord, where the women wove chettiin for the grove.

8 And he brought up all the priests from the cities of Judah and defiled the high places where the priests had burned incense, from Gabaa to Bersabee. And he demolished the house of the gates by the entrance of the gate of Jesou ruler of the city, on the left of a man in the gate of the city.

9 But the priests of the high places did not go up to the altar of the Lord in Jerusalem; rather, they ate unleavened bread among their brothers.

10 And he defiled Tapheth in the ravine of the son of Ennom, so that no man would make his son or his daughter pass through fire for Moloch.

11 And he put an end to the horses that the kings of Judah had given to the sun at the entrance of the house of the Lord by the treasury of Nathan the king's eunuch in pharourim, and he burned the chariot of the sun with fire.

12 And the altars on the roof of the upper room of Achaz that the kings of Judah had made, and the altars that Manasses had made in the two courts of the house of the Lord, the king demolished and pulled down from there and threw their dust into the torrent Kedron.

13 And the king defiled the house facing Jerusalem on the right of Mount Mosoath, which Salomon king of Israel had built for Astarte, an object of offense of the Sidonians, and for Chamos, an object of offense of Moab, and for Molchol, an abomination of the sons of Ammon.

14 And he crushed the pillars and destroyed the groves and filled their places with human bones.

15 And indeed the altar in Bethel, the high place that Jeroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin, had made, even that altar and the high place he pulled down and crushed its stones and ground them to dust and burned the grove.

16 And Josias turned and saw the tombs there in the city and sent and took the bones from the tombs and burned them upon the altar and defiled it according to the word of the Lord that the man of God spoke when Jeroboam stood at the feast by the altar. And turning, he lifted his eyes to the tomb of the man of God who had spoken these words

17 and said, What is that marker that I see? And the men of the city said to him, It is the man of God who came out of Judah and proclaimed these words that he proclaimed against the altar of Bethel.

18 And he said, Leave it; let no man move his bones. And his bones were spared with the bones of the prophet who had come from Samaria.

19 And also all the houses of the high places in the cities of Samaria that the kings of Israel had made to provoke the Lord, Josias removed, and he did to them all the deeds that he did in Bethel.

20 And he sacrificed all the priests of the high places who were there upon the altars and burned human bones upon them; and he returned to Jerusalem.

21 And the king commanded all the people, saying, Keep the Passover to the Lord our God as it is written in the book of this covenant;

22 for this Passover had not been held since the days of the judges who judged Israel, nor during all the days of the kings of Israel and the kings of Judah,

23 but in the eighteenth year of King Josias the Passover to the Lord was held in Jerusalem.

24 And indeed the consulters and the knowers and the theraphim and the idols and all the objects of offense that were in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem King Josias removed, to establish the words of the law written in the book that Chelkias the priest found in the house of the Lord.

25 Before him there was no king like him who turned to the Lord with all his heart and all his soul and all his strength according to all the law of Moses, and after him none like him arose.

26 But the Lord did not turn from the heat of his great anger, with which his anger burned against Judah for the provocations with which Manasses had provoked him.

27 And the Lord said, I shall also remove Judah from before my face as I removed Israel, and I shall reject this city that I chose, Jerusalem, and the house of which I said, My name shall be there.

28 And the rest of the deeds of Josias and all that he did, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

29 And in his days Pharaoh Nechao king of Egypt went up against the king of the Assyrians to the river Euphrates; and Josias went to meet him, and Nechao put him to death at Mageddo when he saw him.

30 And his servants put him, dead, on a chariot from Mageddo and brought him to Jerusalem and buried him in his tomb in the city of David, and the people of the land took Joachas son of Josias and anointed him and made him king in place of his father.

31 Joachas was a son of twenty-three years when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Amital daughter of Jeremias from Lemna.

32 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord according to all that his fathers had done.

33 And Pharaoh Nechao removed him at Deblatha in the land of Emath so that he would not reign in Jerusalem, and imposed a fine upon the land of a hundred talents of silver and a hundred talents of gold.

34 And Pharaoh Nechao made Eliakim son of Josias king over them in place of Josias his father and changed his name to Joakim; and he took Joachas and brought him to Egypt, and he died there.

35 And Joakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; but he assessed the land to give the silver at the word of Pharaoh; each man according to his assessment gave the silver and the gold with the people of the land to give to Pharaoh Nechao.

36 Joakim was a son of twenty-five years when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Jeldaph daughter of Phedeia from Rouma.

37 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord according to all that his fathers had done.

Chapter 24

1 In his days Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon went up, and Joakim became his servant for three years; and he turned and rebelled against him.

2 And he sent against him the bands of the Chaldeans and the bands of Syria and the bands of Moab and the bands of the sons of Ammon and sent them into the land of Judah to prevail, according to the word of the Lord that he spoke by the hand of his servants the prophets.

3 But it was upon the anger of the Lord against Judah to remove it from before his face because of the sins of Manasses, according to all that he did;

4 and indeed he poured out innocent blood and filled Jerusalem with innocent blood, and the Lord was unwilling to show mercy.

5 And the rest of the deeds of Joakim and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?

6 And Joakim slept with his fathers, and Joakim his son reigned in his stead.

7 And the king of Egypt no longer continued to go out of his land, for the king of Babylon had taken from the torrent of Egypt to the river Euphrates all that belonged to the king of Egypt.

8 Joakim was a son of eighteen years when he began to reign, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Nestha daughter of Ellanathan from Jerusalem.

9 And he did evil in the eyes of the Lord according to all that his father had done.

10 At that time Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon went up to Jerusalem, and the city came under siege.

11 And Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon entered the city, and his servants were besieging it.

12 And Joakim king of Judah went out to the king of Babylon, he and his servants and his mother and his commanders and his eunuchs, and the king of Babylon took him in the eighth year of his reign.

13 And he brought out from there all the treasures of the house of the Lord and the treasures of the king's house and cut up all the gold vessels that Salomon king of Israel had made in the temple of the Lord, according to the word of the Lord.

14 And he deported Jerusalem and all the commanders and the mighty in strength, ten thousand captives, and every craftsman and metalworker, and none remained except the poor of the land.

15 And he deported Joakim to Babylon and the king's mother and the king's wives and his eunuchs; and he led the strong men of the land into exile from Jerusalem to Babylon,

16 and all the men of the force, seven thousand, and the craftsmen and metalworkers, one thousand, all mighty men making war; and the king of Babylon brought them as exiles to Babylon.

17 And the king of Babylon made Matthanias his son king in his stead and gave him the name Sedekias.

18 Sedekias was a son of twenty-one years when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem; and his mother's name was Amital daughter of Jeremias.

19 And he did evil before the Lord according to all that Joakim had done;

20 for the anger of the Lord was upon Jerusalem and Judah until he cast them away from before his face. And Sedekias rebelled against the king of Babylon.

Chapter 25

1 And it happened in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, that Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon and all his force came against Jerusalem and encamped against it and built a surrounding wall around it.

2 And the city came under siege until the eleventh year of King Sedekias;

3 on the ninth of the month the famine grew strong in the city, and there was no bread for the people of the land.

4 And the city was breached, and all the men of war went out by night through the gate between the walls, which is by the king's garden, while the Chaldeans were all around the city. And he went by the road to the Araba,

5 and the force of the Chaldeans pursued the king and overtook him in the plains of Jericho, and all his force was scattered from him.

6 And they captured the king and brought him to the king of Babylon at Deblatha, and he pronounced judgment upon him;

7 and he slaughtered the sons of Sedekias before his eyes, and blinded the eyes of Sedekias and bound him in fetters and brought him to Babylon.

8 And in the fifth month, on the seventh of the month [the same year was the nineteenth of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon], Nabouzardan the chief cook, who stood before the king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem.

9 And he burned the house of the Lord and the king's house and all the houses of Jerusalem, and every house burned

10 the chief cook.

11 And the surplus of the people left in the city and those who had gone over to the king of Babylon and the rest of the support Nabouzardan the chief cook removed.

12 And the chief cook left some of the poor of the land as vine dressers and as gabin.

13 And the Chaldeans crushed the bronze pillars in the house of the Lord and the mechonoth and the bronze sea in the house of the Lord and carried their bronze to Babylon.

14 And he took the cauldrons and the iamin and the bowls and the censers and all the bronze vessels with which they ministered;

15 and the chief cook took the fire pans and the bowls of gold and of silver,

16 two pillars, the one sea and the mechonoth that Salomon had made for the house of the Lord; there was no weighing the bronze of all the vessels.

17 The height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits, and the bronze chothar upon it, and the height of the chothar was three cubits, sabacha and roai upon the chothar all around, all bronze; and the second pillar was like it with the sabacha.

18 And the chief cook took Saraias the first priest and Sophonias son of the second order and the three who kept the station,

19 and from the city he took one eunuch who was overseer of the fighting men, and five men who saw the king's face who were found in the city, and the scribe of the commander of the force who mustered the people of the land, and sixty men of the people of the land found in the city;

20 and Nabouzardan the chief cook took them and led them to the king of Babylon at Deblatha,

21 and the king of Babylon struck them and put them to death at Deblatha in the land of Aimath. And Judah was deported from its land.

22 And the people left in the land of Judah, whom Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon had left, he appointed Godolias son of Achikam son of Saphan over them.

23 And all the commanders of the force, they and their men, heard that the king of Babylon had appointed Godolias, and they came to Godolias at Massephath: Ismael son of Nathanias and Joanan son of Karee and Saraias son of Thanemath the Netophathite and Jezonias son of the Machathite, they and their men.

24 And Godolias swore to them and to their men and said to them, Do not fear the passage of the Chaldeans; dwell in the land and serve the king of Babylon, and it shall be well with you.

25 And it happened in the seventh month that Ismael son of Nathanias son of Elisama, of the royal seed, came with ten men; and he struck Godolias, and he died, and the Judeans and the Chaldeans who were with him at Massephath.

26 And all the people from small to great and the commanders of the forces arose and went into Egypt, for they feared the Chaldeans.

27 And it happened in the thirty-seventh year of the exile of Joakim king of Judah, in the twelfth month, on the twenty-seventh of the month, that Evilmarodach king of Babylon, in the year of his reign, lifted the head of Joakim king of Judah and brought him out of his prison house

28 and spoke good things with him and placed his throne above the thrones of the kings who were with him in Babylon,

29 and changed his prison garments, and he ate bread continually before him all the days of his life;

30 and his provision, a continual provision, was given him from the king's house, a day's portion on its day, all the days of his life.

1 Chronicles

Chapter 1

1 Adam, Seth, Enos,

2 Kainan, Maleleel, Jared,

3 Enoch, Mathousala, Lamech,

4 Noe. Sons of Noe: Sem, Cham, Japheth.

5 Sons of Japheth: Gamer, Magog, Madai, Jovan, Elisa, Thobel, Mosoch and Thiras.

6 And sons of Gamer: Aschanaz and Riphath and Thorgama.

7 And sons of Jovan: Elisa and Tharsis, Kitians and Rhodians.

8 And sons of Cham: Chous and Mestraim, Phoud and Chanaan.

9 And sons of Chous: Saba and Euilat and Sabatha and Regma and Sebekatha. And sons of Regma: Saba and Oudadan.

10 And Chous fathered Nebrod; he began to be a giant hunter upon the earth.

17 Sons of Sem: Ailam and Assour and Arphaxad,

24 Sala,

25 Eber, Phalek, Ragau,

26 Serouch, Nachor, Thara,

27 Abraham.

28 And sons of Abraham: Isaac and Ismael.

29 And these are the generations of Ismael the firstborn: Nabaioth and Kedar, Nabdeel, Mabsan,

30 Masma, Idouma, Masse, Chodad, Thaiman,

31 Jettour, Naphes and Kedma. These are the sons of Ismael.

32 And sons of Chettoura, Abraham's concubine: she bore him Zembran, Jexan, Madan, Madiam, Sobak, Soe. And sons of Jexan: Saba and Daidan.

33 And sons of Madiam: Gaipha and Opher and Enoch and Abida and Eldaa. All these are sons of Chettoura.

34 And Abraham fathered Isaac. And sons of Isaac: Esau and Jacob.

35 Sons of Esau: Eliphas and Ragouel and Jeoul and Jeglom and Kore.

36 Sons of Eliphas: Thaiman and Omar, Sophar and Gootham and Kenez and, of Thamna, Amalek.

37 And sons of Ragouel: Nacheth, Zare, Some and Moze.

38 Sons of Seir: Lotan, Sobal, Sebegon, Ana, Deson, Osar, Daison.

39 And sons of Lotan: Chorri and Aiman and Ailath and Namna.

40 Sons of Sobal: Golam, Manachath, Gaibel, Sob and Onam. And sons of Sebegon: Aia and Ana.

41 Sons of Ana: Daison. And sons of Deson: Emeron and Eseban and Jethran and Charran.

42 And sons of Osar: Balaan and Zoukan and Jokan. Sons of Daison: Os and Arran.

43 And these are their kings: Balak son of Beor, and the name of his city was Dennaba.

44 And Balak died, and Jobab son of Zara from Bosorra reigned in his stead.

45 And Jobab died, and Asom from the land of the Thaimanians reigned in his stead.

46 And Asom died, and Adad son of Barad, who struck Madiam in the plain of Moab, reigned in his stead, and the name of his city was Geththaim.

47 And Adad died, and Samaa from Masekka reigned in his stead.

48 And Samaa died, and Saoul from Rooboth by the river reigned in his stead.

49 And Saoul died, and Balaennon son of Achobor reigned in his stead.

50 And Balaennon son of Achobor died, and Adad son of Barad reigned in his stead, and the name of his city was Phogor.

51 And Adad died. And there were leaders of Edom: leader Thamana, leader Gola, leader Jetheth,

52 leader Elibamas, leader Elas, leader Phinon,

53 leader Kenez, leader Thaiman, leader Mabsar,

54 leader Megediel, leader Eram. These are leaders of Edom.

Chapter 2

1 These are the names of the sons of Israel: Reuben, Symeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zaboulon,

2 Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Nephthali, Gad, Aser.

3 Sons of Judah: Er, Aunan, Selon, three; they were born to him of the daughter of Saua the Chanaanite. And Er the firstborn of Judah was evil before the Lord, and he killed him.

4 And Thamar his daughter-in-law bore him Phares and Zara. All the sons of Judah were five.

5 Sons of Phares: Arson and Jemouel.

6 And sons of Zara: Zambri and Aithan and Aiman and Chalchal and Dara, five in all.

7 And sons of Charmi: Achar the hinderer of Israel, who transgressed in the devoted thing.

8 And sons of Aithan: Azarias.

9 And sons of Eseron born to him: Jerameel and Ram and Chaleb and Aram.

10 And Aram fathered Aminadab, and Aminadab fathered Naasson, ruler of the house of Judah,

11 and Naasson fathered Salmon, and Salmon fathered Boos,

12 and Boos fathered Obed, and Obed fathered Jessai,

13 and Jessai fathered Eliab his firstborn; Aminadab the second, Samaa the third,

14 Nathanael the fourth, Raddai the fifth,

15 Asom the sixth, David the seventh.

16 And their sisters were Sarouia and Abigaia. And sons of Sarouia: Abessa and Joab and Asael, three.

17 And Abigaia bore Amessa; and Amessa's father was Jothor the Ismaelite.

18 And Chaleb son of Eseron fathered Gazouba a wife and Jerioth. And these were her sons: Joasar and Sobab and Orna.

19 And Gazouba died, and Chaleb took Ephrath for himself, and she bore him Or;

20 and Or fathered Ouri, and Ouri fathered Beseleel.

21 And after these things Eseron went in to the daughter of Machir father of Galaad, and he took her, being sixty years old, and she bore him Segoub.

22 And Segoub fathered Jair. And he had twenty-three cities in Galaad;

23 and Gedsour and Aram took the villages of Jair from them, Kanath and its villages, sixty cities; all these belonged to the sons of Machir father of Galaad.

24 And after Eseron died Chaleb went to Ephratha. And Eseron's wife Abia bore him Aschod father of Thekoe.

25 And the sons of Jeremeel the firstborn of Eseron were Ram the firstborn, and Baana and Aran and Asom his brother.

26 And Jeremeel had another wife, and her name was Atara; she was the mother of Ozom.

27 And the sons of Ram the firstborn of Jeremeel were Maas and Jamin and Akor.

28 And the sons of Ozom were Samai and Jadae. And sons of Samai: Nadab and Abisour.

29 And the name of Abisour's wife was Abichail, and she bore him Achabar and Molid.

30 Sons of Nadab: Salad and Aphphaim. And Salad died without children.

31 And sons of Aphphaim: Jisemiel. And sons of Jisemiel: Sosan. And sons of Sosan: Achlai.

32 And sons of Jadae: Achisamai, Jether, Jonathan; and Jether died without children.

33 And sons of Jonathan: Phaleth and Ozaza. These were sons of Jeremeel.

34 And Sosan had no sons, only daughters; and Sosan had an Egyptian servant named Jochiel,

35 and Sosan gave his daughter to his servant Jochiel as a wife, and she bore him Eththi.

36 And Eththi fathered Nathan, and Nathan fathered Zabed,

37 and Zabed fathered Aphaleel, and Aphaleel fathered Obed,

38 and Obed fathered Jeou, and Jeou fathered Azarias,

39 and Azarias fathered Chelles, and Chelles fathered Eleasa,

40 and Eleasa fathered Sosomai, and Sosomai fathered Saloum,

41 and Saloum fathered Jechemias, and Jechemias fathered Elisama.

42 And sons of Chaleb brother of Jeremeel: Marisa his firstborn, he was father of Ziph; and sons of Marisa father of Chebron.

43 And sons of Chebron: Kore and Thapous and Rekom and Semaa.

44 And Semaa fathered Raem father of Jerkaan, and Jerkaan fathered Samai;

45 and his son was Maon, and Maon was father of Baithsour.

46 And Gaipha the concubine of Chaleb bore Arran and Mosa and Gezoue. And Arran fathered Gezoue.

47 And sons of Jadai: Ragem and Joatham and Gersom and Phalet and Gaipha and Sagaph.

48 And Mocha the concubine of Chaleb bore Saber and Tharchna.

49 And she bore Sagaph father of Marmina and Saou father of Machabena and father of Gaibaa; and Chaleb's daughter was Ascha.

50 These were sons of Chaleb. Sons of Or the firstborn of Ephratha: Sobal father of Kariathiarim,

51 Salomon father of Baithlaem, Arim father of Baithgedor.

52 And Sobal father of Kariathiarim had sons: Araa, Esi, Ammanith,

53 Emospheos, city of Jair, Aithalim and Miphithim and Esamathim and Emasaraim; from these came the Sarathaians and the Esthaolaians.

54 Sons of Salomon: Baithlaem, Netophathi, Ataroth of the house of Joab and half of the Manathi, Esarei,

55 families of scribes dwelling at Jabes: Thargathiim, Samathiim, Sokathiim; these are the Kenites who came from Mesema father of the house of Rechab.

Chapter 3

1 And these were the sons of David born to him in Chebron: the firstborn Amnon by Achinaam the Jezraelite, the second Daniel by Abigaia the Carmelite,

2 the third Abessalom son of Mocha daughter of Tholmai king of Gedsour, the fourth Adonia son of Aggith,

3 the fifth Saphatia by Abital, the sixth Jethraam by Agla his wife.

4 Six were born to him in Chebron, and he reigned there seven years and six months. And he reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem,

5 and these were born to him in Jerusalem: Samaa, Sobab, Nathan and Salomon, four by Bersabee daughter of Amiel,

6 and Ibaar and Elisama and Eliphalet

7 and Nage and Naphag and Janoue

8 and Elisama and Eliada and Eliphalet, nine.

9 All were sons of David apart from the sons of the concubines, and Themar was their sister.

10 Sons of Salomon: Roboam, Abia his son, Asa his son, Josaphat his son,

11 Joram his son, Ochozias his son, Joas his son,

12 Amasias his son, Azarias his son, Joathan his son,

13 Achaz his son, Ezekias his son, Manasses his son,

14 Amon his son, Josias his son.

15 And sons of Josias: firstborn Joanan, second Joakim, third Sedekias, fourth Saloum.

16 And sons of Joakim: Jechonias his son, Sedekias his son.

17 And sons of Jechonias—asir: Salathiel his son,

18 Melchiram and Phadaias and Sanesar and Jekemia and Osamo and Denethi.

19 And sons of Salathiel: Zorobabel and Semei. And sons of Zorobabel: Mosollamos and Ananias, and Salomith their sister,

20 and Asoube and Ool and Barachia and Asadia and Asobaesd, five.

21 And sons of Ananias: Phalletia, and Isaia his son, Raphaia his son, Orna his son, Abdia his son, Sechenia his son.

22 And son of Sechenia: Samaia. And sons of Samaia: Chattous and Joel and Mari and Noadia and Saphath, six.

23 And sons of Noadia: Elithenan and Ezekias and Ezrikam, three.

24 And sons of Elithenan: Odouia and Eliasib and Phalaia and Akoun and Joanan and Dalaia and Anani, seven.

Chapter 4

1 And sons of Judah: Phares, Arson and Charmi and Or, Soubal

2 and Raia his son; and Soubal fathered Jeth, and Jeth fathered Achimi and Laad; these are the generations of the Sarathite.

3 And these were sons of Aitam: Jezrael and Ragma and Jabas, and their sister's name was Eselebbōn.

4 And Phanouel father of Gedor, and Azir father of Osan. These were sons of Or the firstborn of Ephratha father of Baithlaem.

5 And Saour father of Thekoe had two wives, Aoda and Thoada.

6 And Aoda bore him Ochazam and Ephad and Thaiman and Astheran; all these were sons of Aoda.

7 And sons of Thoada: Sareth and Saar and Ethnan.

8 And Kos fathered Enob and Sabeba. And generations of the brother of Rechab son of Jarim.

9 And Igabes was more honored than his brothers; and his mother called his name Igabes, saying, I bore as gabes.

10 And Igabes called upon the God of Israel, saying, If you will surely bless me and enlarge my borders and your hand be with me, then you will make knowledge so as not to humble me. And God brought about all that he asked.

11 And Chaleb father of Ascha fathered Machir; he was father of Assathon.

12 And Assathon fathered Bathrephan and Phessie and Thana father of the city Naas, brother of Eselon the Kenezite; these were men of Repha.

13 And sons of Kenez: Gothoniel and Saraia. And sons of Gothoniel: Athath.

14 And Manathi fathered Gophera. And Saraia fathered Joab father of Ageaddair, for they were craftsmen.

15 And sons of Chaleb son of Jephonne: Era, Ala and Noom. And sons of Ala: Kenez.

16 And his son Geseel, Ameachi and Zapha and Zaira and Eserael.

17 And sons of Esri: Jether, Morad and Apher and Jalon. And Jether fathered Maron and Semai and Mareth father of Esthemon.

18 And his wife [this is Adia] bore Jared father of Gedor and Aber father of Sochon and Jekthiel father of Zano; and these were sons of Gelia daughter of Pharaoh, whom Mored took.

19 And sons of the wife of Idouia sister of Nachem. And Dalia father of Keila, and Semeion father of Joman. And sons of Naem father of Keila: Agarmi and Esthemoe the Machathite.

20 And sons of Semeion: Amnon and Rana, son of Anan and Thilon. And sons of Jesei: Zoath and sons of Zoath.

21 Sons of Selom son of Judah: Er father of Lecha and Laada father of Maresa and generations of houses, ephrath abak, of the house of Esoba

22 and Joakim and men of Chozeba and Joas and Saraph, who dwelt in Moab; and he brought them back, abederin athoukiin.

23 These were potters dwelling in Nataim and Gadera; with the king in his kingdom they became strong and dwelt there.

24 Sons of Symeon: Namouel and Jamin, Jarib, Zare, Saoul;

25 Salem his son, Mabasam his son, Masma his son,

26 Amouel his son, Saboud his son, Zakchour his son, Semei his son.

27 And Semei had sixteen sons and three daughters; and their brothers had not many sons; and all their families did not increase like the sons of Judah.

28 And they dwelt in Bersabee and Sama and Molada and Esersoual

29 and in Balaa and Boasom and Thoulad

30 and Bathouel and Erma and Seklag

31 and Baithmarchaboth and half of Sosim and the house of Baroumseorim; these were their cities until King David.

32 And their settlements: Aitam and Enremmon and Thokkan and Aisan, five cities.

33 And all their settlements around these cities as far as Baal; this was their holding and their enrollment.

34 And Mosobab and Jemoloch and Josias son of Amasias

35 and Joel [and he was son of Isabia], son of Saraia, son of Asiel,

36 and Elioenai and Jakaba and Jasouia and Asaia and Ediel and Ismael and Banaia

37 and Zouza son of Sephei son of Allon son of Jedia son of Samari son of Samaiou.

38 These who passed by in names of rulers in their generations; and in the houses of their families they increased into a multitude.

39 And they went as far as the entrance of Gerara, to the east of Gai, to seek pastures for their livestock;

40 and they found rich and good pastures, and the land was broad before them and peaceful and quiet, for those dwelling there before were of the sons of Cham.

41 And these recorded by name came in the days of Ezekias king of Judah and struck their houses and the Minaeans whom they found there and devoted them to destruction until this day and dwelt in their stead, for there were pastures for their livestock there.

42 And from them, from the sons of Symeon, five hundred men went to Mount Seir, and Phalettia and Noadia and Raphaia and Oziel sons of Jesi were their leaders;

43 and they struck the remnant left of Amalek and dwelt there until this day.

Chapter 5

1 And sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel, for he was the firstborn, but when he went up to his father's bed he gave his blessing to his son Joseph son of Israel, and he was not reckoned in the genealogy for the birthright;

2 for Judah was mighty in strength and among his brothers and a leader came from him, but the blessing belonged to Joseph.

3 Sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel: Enoch and Phallous, Arson and Charmi.

4 Sons of Joel: Semei and Banaia his son. And sons of Goug son of Semei:

5 his son Micha, his son Recha, his son Baal,

6 his son Beera, whom Thaglathphalnasar king of Assour deported; he was ruler of the Reubenites.

7 And his brothers by his family in their enrollments according to their generations: the ruler Joel and Zacharias

8 and Balek son of Ozouz son of Sama son of Joel; he dwelt in Aroer and as far as Nabau and Beelmaon,

9 and eastward he dwelt as far as the approaches of the wilderness from the river Euphrates, for their livestock were numerous in the land of Galaad.

10 And in the days of Saoul they made war against the sojourners, and they fell into their hands, dwelling in tents throughout the east of Galaad.

11 Sons of Gad dwelt opposite them in Basan as far as Selcha.

12 Joel the firstborn, Sapham the second, and Jani the scribe in Basan.

13 And their brothers by the houses of their families: Michael, Mosollam and Sebee and Joree and Jachan and Zoue and Obed, seven.

14 These were sons of Abichail son of Ouri son of Idai son of Galaad son of Michael son of Isai son of Jouri son of Zaboucham

15 son of Abdiel son of Gouni, ruler of a family house.

16 They dwelt in Galaad, in Basan and its villages and all the surrounding lands of Saron as far as the exit.

17 The enrollment of them all was in the days of Joatham king of Judah and the days of Jeroboam king of Israel.

18 Sons of Reuben and Gad and half the tribe of Manasseh, of sons of strength, men bearing shields and sword and drawing the bow and trained for war, forty-four thousand seven hundred and sixty going out in battle array.

19 And they made war with the Agarenes and Ituraeans and Naphisaeans and Nadabaeans

20 and prevailed over them, and the Agaraeans and all their encampments were given into their hands, for they cried to God in the war, and he heard them because they hoped in him.

21 And they took their baggage captive: five thousand camels and two hundred fifty thousand sheep, two thousand donkeys and one hundred thousand human souls;

22 for many wounded fell, for the war was from God. And they dwelt in their stead until the deportation.

23 And the half tribe of Manasseh dwelt in the land from Basan as far as Baalermon and Sanir and Mount Aermon; and in Lebanon they multiplied.

24 And these were the heads of their family houses: Opher and Jesei and Eliel and Esdriel and Jermia and Odouia and Jediel, men mighty in strength, men of renown, rulers of their family houses.

25 And they rebelled against the God of their fathers and prostituted themselves after the gods of the peoples of the land whom God had removed before them.

26 And the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Phaloch king of Assour and the spirit of Thaglathphalnasar king of Assour, and he deported Reuben and Gad and the half tribe of Manasseh and led them to Chalach and Chabor and to the river Gozan until this day.

27 Sons of Levi: Gedson, Kaath and Merari.

28 And sons of Kaath: Ambram and Issaar, Chebron and Oziel.

29 And sons of Ambram: Aaron and Moses and Mariam. And sons of Aaron: Nadab and Abioud, Eleazar and Ithamar.

30 Eleazar fathered Phinees, Phinees fathered Abisou,

31 Abisou fathered Bokai, Bokai fathered Ozi,

32 Ozi fathered Zaraia, Zaraia fathered Mariel,

33 and Mariel fathered Amaria, and Amaria fathered Achitob,

34 and Achitob fathered Sadok, and Sadok fathered Achimaas,

35 and Achimaas fathered Azarias, and Azarias fathered Joanan,

36 and Joanas fathered Azarias; he served as priest in the house that Salomon built in Jerusalem.

37 And Azarias fathered Amaria, and Amaria fathered Achitob,

38 and Achitob fathered Sadok, and Sadok fathered Salom,

39 and Salom fathered Chelkias, and Chelkias fathered Azarias,

40 and Azarias fathered Saraias, and Saraias fathered Josadak.

41 And Josadak went into exile with Judah and Jerusalem by the hand of Nabouchodonosor.

Chapter 6

1 Sons of Levi: Gedson, Kaath and Merari.

2 And these are the names of the sons of Gedson: Lobeni and Semei.

3 Sons of Kaath: Ambram and Issaar, Chebron and Oziel.

4 Sons of Merari: Mooli and Omousi. And these are the families of Levi according to their families:

5 for Gedson, Lobeni his son, Jeeth his son, Zemma his son,

6 Joach his son, Addi his son, Zara his son, Jethri his son.

7 Sons of Kaath: Aminadab his son, Kore his son, Asir his son,

8 Elkana his son, and Abiasaph his son, Asir his son,

9 Thaath his son, Ouriel his son, Ozias his son, Saoul his son.

10 And sons of Elkana: Amasi and Achimoth,

11 Elkana his son, Souphi his son and Naath his son,

12 Eliab his son, Idaer his son, Elkana his son.

13 Sons of Samuel: the firstborn Sani and Abia.

14 Sons of Merari: Mooli, Lobeni his son, Semei his son, Oza his son,

15 Somea his son, Aggia his son, Asaia his son.

16 And these are the ones whom David appointed over the hands of the singers in the house of the Lord at the resting of the ark,

17 and they ministered before the tent of the house of testimony with instruments until Salomon built the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, and they stood according to their ordinance for their services.

18 And these were those standing, and their sons, from the sons of Kaath: Aiman the singer, son of Joel son of Samuel

19 son of Elkana son of Edad son of Eliel son of Thie

20 son of Souph son of Elkana son of Meth' son of Amasias

21 son of Elkana son of Joel son of Azarias son of Saphanias

22 son of Thaath son of Asir son of Abiasaph son of Kore

23 son of Issaar son of Kaath son of Levi son of Israel.

24 And his brother Asaph stood on his right: Asaph son of Barachias son of Samaa

25 son of Michael son of Maasias son of Melchias

26 son of Athani son of Zarai son of Adia

27 son of Aithan son of Zamma son of Semei

28 son of Echa son of Gedson son of Levi.

29 And the sons of Merari their brother were on the left: Aithan son of Kisai son of Abdi son of Maloch

30 son of Asebi son of Amessias son of Chelkias

31 son of Amasai son of Bani son of Semmer

32 son of Mooli son of Mousi son of Merari son of Levi.

33 And their brothers by their family houses, the Levites, were given for every work of service of the tent of the house of God.

34 And Aaron and his sons burned incense upon the altar of whole burnt offerings and upon the altar of incense for every work of the holy of holies and to make atonement for Israel according to all that Moses the servant of God had commanded.

35 And these were sons of Aaron: Eleazar his son, Phinees his son, Abisou his son,

36 Bokai his son, Ozi his son, Zaraia his son,

37 Mariel his son, Amaria his son, Achitob his son,

38 Sadok his son, Achimaas his son.

39 And these were their dwelling places in their villages within their borders, for the sons of Aaron of the family of Kaath—for the lot fell to them—

40 and they gave them Chebron in the land of Judah and its surrounding lands around it;

41 but the fields of the city and its villages they gave to Chaleb son of Jephonne.

42 And to the sons of Aaron they gave the cities of refuge, Chebron and Lobna and its surrounding lands and Selna and its surrounding lands and Esthamo and its surrounding lands

43 and Jeththar and its surrounding lands and Dabir and its surrounding lands

44 and Asan and its surrounding lands and Attan and its surrounding lands and Basamys and its surrounding lands,

45 and from the tribe of Benjamin, Gabee and its surrounding lands and Galemeth and its surrounding lands and Agchoch and its surrounding lands; all their cities were thirteen cities according to their families.

46 And to the remaining sons of Kaath, from the families of the tribe, from the half tribe of Manasseh, ten cities by lot.

47 And to the sons of Gedson according to their families, from the tribe of Issachar, from the tribe of Aser, from the tribe of Nephthali, from the tribe of Manasseh in Basan, thirteen cities.

48 And to the sons of Merari according to their families, from the tribe of Reuben, from the tribe of Gad, from the tribe of Zaboulon, twelve cities by lot.

49 And the sons of Israel gave to the Levites the cities and their surrounding lands;

50 and by lot they gave from the tribe of the sons of Judah and from the tribe of the sons of Symeon these cities, which he called by name.

51 And from the families of the sons of Kaath there were cities of their borders from the tribe of Ephraim.

52 And they gave him the cities of refuge, Sychem and its surrounding lands in Mount Ephraim and Gazer and its surrounding lands

53 and Jekmaam and its surrounding lands and Baithoron and its surrounding lands

54 and Eglam and its surrounding lands and Gethremmon and its surrounding lands

55 and from the half tribe of Manasseh, Anar and its surrounding lands and Jeblaam and its surrounding lands according to family for the remaining sons of Kaath.

56 To the sons of Gedson from the families of the half tribe of Manasseh, Golan from Basan and its surrounding lands and Aseroth and its surrounding lands,

57 and from the tribe of Issachar, Kedes and its surrounding lands and Deberi and its surrounding lands

58 and Dabor and its surrounding lands and Anam and its surrounding lands,

59 and from the tribe of Aser, Masal and its surrounding lands and Abaran and its surrounding lands

60 and Ikak and its surrounding lands and Roob and its surrounding lands,

61 and from the tribe of Nephthali, Kedes in Galilaia and its surrounding lands and Chamoth and its surrounding lands and Kariathaim and its surrounding lands.

62 To the remaining sons of Merari from the tribe of Zaboulon, Remmon and its surrounding lands and Thachchia and its surrounding lands,

63 and from across the Jordan at Jericho, to the west of the Jordan, from the tribe of Reuben, Bosor in the wilderness and its surrounding lands and Jasa and its surrounding lands

64 and Kademoth and its surrounding lands and Mophaa and its surrounding lands,

65 and from the tribe of Gad, Ramoth Galaad and its surrounding lands and Maanaim and its surrounding lands

66 and Esebon and its surrounding lands and Jazir and its surrounding lands.

Chapter 7

1 And for the sons of Issachar: Thola and Phoua and Jasoub and Semeron, four.

2 And sons of Thola: Ozi and Raphaia and Jeriel and Jemou and Jebasam and Samuel, rulers of their family houses for Thola, mighty in strength according to their generations. Their number in David's days was twenty-two thousand six hundred.

3 And sons of Ozi: Jezria, and sons of Jezria: Michael and Obdia and Joel and Jesia, five, all rulers.

4 And with them according to their generations by their ancestral houses were thirty-six thousand mighty men for battle, for they had multiplied wives and sons.

5 And their brothers in all the families of Issachar, mighty in strength, numbered eighty-seven thousand in all.

6 Benjamin: Bale and Bachir and Jadiel, three.

7 And sons of Bale: Asebon and Ozi and Oziel and Jerimoth and Ouri, five rulers of ancestral houses, mighty in strength. And their number was twenty-two thousand and thirty-four.

8 And sons of Bachir: Zamarias and Joas and Eliezer and Elithenan and Amaria and Jerimoth and Abiou and Anathoth and Gemeeth. All these were sons of Bachir.

9 And their number according to their generations, rulers of their family houses, mighty in strength, was twenty thousand two hundred.

10 And sons of Jadiel: Balaan. And sons of Balaan: Jaous and Benjamin and Aoth and Chanana and Zaithan and Ramessai and Achisaar.

11 All these were sons of Jadiel, rulers of the families, mighty in strength, seventeen thousand two hundred going out in force to fight.

12 And Sapphin and Apphin and sons of Raom: his son Aer.

13 Sons of Nephthali: Jasiel and Goni and Issier and Salom, sons of Balaa.

14 Sons of Manasseh: Aseriel, whom his Syrian concubine bore; she bore Machir father of Galaad.

15 And Machir took a wife for Amphin and Mamphin; and his sister's name was Moocha. And the second one's name was Salpaad, and daughters were born to Salpaad.

16 And Moocha wife of Machir bore a son and called his name Phares, and his brother's name was Soros; his son was Oulam.

17 And sons of Oulam: Badan. These were sons of Galaad son of Machir son of Manasseh.

18 And his sister Malecheth bore Isadek and Abiezer and Maela.

19 And the sons of Semira were Jaaim and Sychem and Lakei and Aniam.

20 And sons of Ephraim: Sothala, and Barad his son, and Thaath his son, Eleada his son, Nomee his son,

21 Zabed his son, Sothele his son and Ezer and Elead. And the men of Geth born in the land killed them because they went down to take their livestock.

22 And Ephraim their father mourned many days, and his brothers came to comfort him.

23 And he went in to his wife, and she conceived and bore a son, and he called his name Baraga, because, In evils it happened in my house.

24 And among those who remained he built lower and upper Baithoron. And sons of Ozan: Seera

25 and Raphi his sons, Raseph and Thale his sons, Thaen his son.

26 Laadan his son, Amioud his son, Elisama his son,

27 Noum his son, Jesoue his son.

28 And their holding and dwelling place: Bethel and its villages, to the east Naaran, to the west Gazer and its villages; and Sychem and its villages as far as Gaian and its villages.

29 And as far as the borders of the sons of Manasseh: Baithsaan and its villages, Thaanach and its villages and Balad and its villages, Mageddo and its villages, Dor and its villages. In these the sons of Joseph son of Israel dwelt.

30 Sons of Aser: Jemna and Isoua and Isoui and Beriga, and Sore their sister.

31 And sons of Beriga: Chaber and Melchiel, who was father of Berzaith.

32 And Chaber fathered Japhalet and Samer and Chotham and Sola their sister.

33 And sons of Japhalet: Phesechi, Bamael and Asith; these were sons of Japhalet.

34 And sons of Semmer: Achiouraoga and Oba and Aram

35 and Baneelam; his brothers were Sophas and Imana and Selles and Amal.

36 Sons of Sophas: Chouchi, Arnaphar and Soual and Bari and Imari,

37 Sobal and Od and Semma and Salisa and Jethran and Beera.

38 And sons of Jether: Iphina and Phaspha and Ara.

39 And sons of Ola: Orech, Aniel and Rasia.

40 All these were sons of Aser, all chosen rulers of families mighty in strength, leading rulers; their number in battle array for fighting was twenty-six thousand men.

Chapter 8

1 And Benjamin fathered Bale his firstborn and Asbel the second, Aara the third,

2 Noa the fourth and Raphi the fifth.

3 And Bale had sons: Ader and Gera and Abioud

4 and Abisoue and Nooma and Achia

5 and Gera and Sopharphak and Oim.

6 These were sons of Aod; these were rulers of families for those dwelling in Gabee, and they deported them to Manachathi;

7 and Nooma and Achia and Gera; he was iglaam and fathered Naana and Achichod.

8 And Saarim fathered in the plain of Moab after he sent away Osim and Baada his wife.

9 And by Ada his wife he fathered Jobab and Sebia and Misa and Melcham

10 and Jaos and Sabia and Marma; these were rulers of families.

11 And by Osim he fathered Abitob and Alphaal.

12 And sons of Alphaal: Obed, Messaam, Semmer; he built Ono and Lod and its villages.

13 And Beriga and Sama; these were rulers of the families for those dwelling in Ailam, and they drove out those dwelling in Geth.

14 And his brother Sosek and Jarimoth

15 and Zabadia and Orer and Oded

16 and Michael and Jespha and Jocha, sons of Bariga.

17 And Zabadia and Mosollam and Azaki and Abar

18 and Isamari and Jezlia and Jobab, sons of Elphaal.

19 And Jakim and Zechri and Zabdi

20 and Elioenai and Salthi and Elieli

21 and Adaia and Baraia and Samarath, sons of Samai.

22 And Isphan and Obed and Eleel

23 and Abadon and Zechri and Anan

24 and Anania and Ambri and Ailam and Anathothia

25 and Athin and Jepheria and Pheliel, sons of Sosek.

26 And Samsaria and Saaria and Ogotholia

27 and Jarasia and Elia and Zechri, sons of Iraam.

28 These were rulers of families according to their generations, rulers; these dwelt in Jerusalem.

29 And in Gabaon dwelt the father of Gabaon, and his wife's name was Maacha.

30 And her firstborn son was Abadon, and Sour and Kis and Baal and Ner and Nadab

31 and Gedour and his brother and Zachour and Makaloth;

32 and Makaloth fathered Semaa. For they too dwelt opposite their brothers in Jerusalem with their brothers.

33 And Ner fathered Kis, and Kis fathered Saoul, and Saoul fathered Jonathan and Melchisoue and Aminadab and Asabal.

34 And sons of Jonathan: Meribaal. And Meribaal fathered Michia.

35 And sons of Michia: Phithon and Melchel and Theree and Achaz.

36 And Achaz fathered Joiada, and Joiada fathered Galemath and Asmoth and Zambri, and Zambri fathered Maisa;

37 and Maisa fathered Baana; Raphaia his son, Elasa his son, Esel his son.

38 And Esel had six sons, and these were their names: Ezrikam his firstborn, and Ismael and Saraia and Abdia and Anan; all these were sons of Esel.

39 And sons of Asel his brother: Ailam his firstborn, and Jais the second, Eliphalet the third.

40 And the sons of Ailam were mighty men of strength who drew the bow and had many sons and sons of sons, one hundred and fifty. All these were of the sons of Benjamin.

Chapter 9

1 And all Israel, their enrollment, and these were recorded in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah with those deported to Babylon for their lawless deeds.

2 And the first inhabitants in their holdings in the cities: Israel, the priests, the Levites and those given.

3 And in Jerusalem there dwelt some of the sons of Judah and of the sons of Benjamin and of the sons of Ephraim and Manasseh:

4 Gothi son of Ammioud son of Amri son of the sons of Phares son of Judah.

5 And of the Selonites: Asaia his firstborn and his sons.

6 Of the sons of Zara: Jiel and their brothers, six hundred and ninety.

7 And of the sons of Benjamin: Salo son of Mosollam son of Odouia son of Sanaa

8 and Ibanaa son of Iraam, and these were sons of Ozi son of Machir; and Massalem son of Saphatia son of Ragouel son of Banaia

9 and their brothers according to their generations, nine hundred fifty-six, all men rulers of families by their family houses.

10 And of the priests: Jodae and Joarim and Jachin

11 and Azarias son of Chelkias son of Mosollam son of Sadok son of Maraioth son of Achitob, leader of the house of God,

12 and Adaia son of Iraam son of Paschor son of Malchias and Maasaias son of Adiel son of Jediou son of Mosollam son of Maselmoth son of Emmer,

13 and their brothers, rulers of family houses, one thousand seven hundred sixty mighty in strength for the work of the service of the house of God.

14 And of the Levites: Samaia son of Asob son of Esrikam son of Asabia, of the sons of Merari,

15 and Bakbakar and Ares and Galal and Manthanias son of Micha son of Zechri son of Asaph,

16 and Abdia son of Samia son of Galal son of Idithon and Barachias son of Ossa son of Elkana, who dwelt in the villages of Netophathi.

17 The gatekeepers: Salom and Akoub and Talman and Aiman and their brothers, Salom the ruler;

18 and until then at the king's gate to the east; these were the gates of the camps of the sons of Levi.

19 And Salom son of Kore son of Abiasaph son of Kore and his brothers in his father's house, the Korites, over the works of service guarding the watches of the tent, and their fathers over the camp of the Lord guarding the entrance.

20 And Phinees son of Eleazar was leader over them before, and these were with him.

21 Zacharias son of Masalami was gatekeeper of the entrance of the tent of testimony.

22 All the chosen at the gates, at the gates, were two hundred twelve; these were in their courts, their enrollment; David and Samuel the seer appointed them in their faithfulness.

23 And they and their sons were over the gates in the house of the Lord, in the house of the tent, to guard it.

24 The gates were toward the four winds, east, sea, north, south.

25 And their brothers in their courts were to come in every seven days from time to time with these;

26 for four mighty men of the gates were in trust. The Levites were over the chambers and the treasuries of the house of God,

27 and they encamped around the house of God, for the guard was upon them, and they were over the keys to open the doors of the sanctuary morning by morning.

28 And some of them were over the vessels of service, for they brought them in by number and brought them out by number.

29 And some of them were appointed over the vessels and all the holy vessels and over the fine flour, wine, oil, frankincense and spices.

30 And some of the sons of the priests were makers of ointment for the ointment and for the spices.

31 And Mattathias of the Levites [he was the firstborn of Salom the Korite] was in trust over the work of the offering of the pan of the high priest.

32 And Banaia the Kaathite of their brothers was over the bread of the presentation to prepare it sabbath by sabbath.

33 And these were singers, rulers of the families of the Levites, assigned daily divisions, for day and night they had the work;

34 these were rulers of the families of the Levites according to their generations, rulers; they dwelt in Jerusalem.

35 And in Gabaon dwelt Jiel father of Gabaon, and his wife's name was Moocha;

36 and his firstborn son was Abadon, and Sir and Kis and Baal and Ner and Nadab

37 and Gedour and a brother and Zacharias and Makelloth.

38 And Makelloth fathered Samaa. And these dwelt among their brothers in Jerusalem with their brothers.

39 And Ner fathered Kis, and Kis fathered Saoul, and Saoul fathered Jonathan and Melchisoue and Aminadab and Isbaal.

40 And Jonathan's son was Maribaal, and Maribaal fathered Micha.

41 And sons of Micha: Phaithon and Malach and Tharach.

42 And Achaz fathered Jada, and Jada fathered Galemeth and Gazmoth and Zambri, and Zambri fathered Masa,

43 and Masa fathered Baana, Raphaia his son, Eleasa his son, Esel his son.

44 And Esel had six sons, and these were their names: Esdrikam his firstborn, Ismael and Saria and Abdia and Anan; these were sons of Esel.

Chapter 10

1 And foreigners fought against Israel, and Israel fled from before the foreigners, and wounded men fell on Mount Gelboue.

2 And foreigners pursued after Saul and after his sons, and foreigners struck Jonathan and Aminadab and Melchisue, sons of Saul.

3 And the battle became heavy upon Saul, and the archers found him with bows and pains, and he was pained from the bows.

4 And Saul said to the one bearing his gear, “Draw your sword and pierce me with it, lest these uncircumcised come and mock me.” And the one bearing his gear was unwilling, because he feared greatly; and Saul took the sword and fell upon it.

5 And the one bearing his gear saw that Saul had died, and he too fell upon his sword and died.

6 And Saul and his three sons died on that day, and all his house died together.

7 And every man of Israel who was in the valley saw that Israel had fled and that Saul and his sons had died, and they abandoned their cities and fled; and foreigners came and settled in them. —

8 And it came to pass on the next day that foreigners came to strip the wounded, and they found Saul and his sons fallen on Mount Gelboue.

9 And they stripped him, and took his head and his gear, and sent them around to the land of the foreigners, to announce good news to their idols and to the people.

10 And they put his gear in the house of their god, and they put his head in the house of Dagon.

11 And all the inhabitants of all Galaad heard all that the foreigners had done to Saul and to Israel.

12 And every valiant man arose from Galaad, and they took the body of Saul and the bodies of his sons, and brought them to Jabis, and buried their bones beneath the oak in Jabis, and they fasted seven days. —

13 And Saul died in his iniquities, which he had committed against the Lord, according to the word of the Lord, because he did not keep it; because Saul inquired at the ventriloquist, to inquire, and Samuel the prophet answered him;

14 and he did not seek the Lord, and he slew him, and turned the kingdom over to David son of Jesse.

Chapter 11

1 And all Israel came to David at Hebron, saying, “Behold, we are your bones and your flesh.

2 And yesterday and the third day, when Saul was king, you were the one leading out and bringing in Israel; and the Lord your God said to you, ‘You shall shepherd my people Israel, and you shall be a leader over Israel.’”

3 And all the elders of Israel came to the king at Hebron, and King David made a covenant with them at Hebron before the Lord; and they anointed David as king over Israel according to the word of the Lord through the hand of Samuel.

4 And the king and the men of Israel went to Jerusalem [this is Jebus], and there were the Jebusites, the inhabitants of the land.

5 And the inhabitants of Jebus said to David, “You shall not enter here.” And he captured the stronghold of Zion [this is the city of David].

6 And David said, “Everyone striking a Jebusite first shall become ruler and commander.” And Joab son of Sarouia went up against it first, and became ruler.

7 And David dwelt in the stronghold; on account of this he called it City of David.

8 And he built the city round about; and he fought and took the city.

9 And David went on, going and becoming great, and the Lord Almighty was with him.

10 And these are the rulers of the mighty men who were with David, those strengthening with him in his kingdom, with all Israel, to make him king according to the word of the Lord over Israel.

11 And this is the number of David’s mighty men: Jesebaal son of Achamani, first of the thirty; he drew his sword once against three hundred wounded men at one time. —

12 And after him, Eleazar son of Dodai the Ahohite; he was among the three mighty men.

13 He was with David at Phasodomin, and the foreigners gathered there for war, and a portion of the field was full of barley, and the people fled from before the foreigners;

14 and he stood in the midst of the portion and saved it, and struck the foreigners, and the Lord worked a great salvation. —

15 And three of the thirty rulers went down to the rock, to David, to the cave of Odollam, and the camp of the foreigners had encamped in the valley of the giants.

16 And David was then in the stronghold, and the troop of the foreigners was then in Bethlehem.

17 And David desired and said, “Who will give me water from the well of Bethlehem, the one at the gate?”

18 And the three broke through the camp of the foreigners and drew water from the well in Bethlehem, the one at the gate, and took it and came to David; and David was unwilling to drink it, and poured it out as a libation to the Lord.

19 And he said, “May God be propitious to me to do this thing! Shall I drink the blood of these men with their lives? For with their lives they brought it.” And he was unwilling to drink it. These things the three mighty men did.

20 And Abessa, brother of Joab, he was ruler of the three; he drew his sword against three hundred wounded men at one time, and he was renowned among the three,

21 more glorious than the two among the three, and he was their ruler, but he did not come as far as the three. —

22 And Banaias son of Jodae, son of a mighty man, his works were many above Kabasael; he struck the two Ariel of Moab; and this same one went down and struck the lion in the pit on a day of snow.

23 And this same one struck the Egyptian man, a visible man of five cubits, and in the Egyptian’s hand was a spear like a weaver’s shuttle; and Banaias went down against him with a rod, and took the spear from the Egyptian’s hand and killed him with his own spear.

24 These things Banaias son of Jodae did, and he had a name among the three mighty men.

25 He was more glorious than the thirty, but he did not come to the three; and David appointed him over his clan.

26 And mighty men of the armies: Asael brother of Joab, Eleanan son of Dodo from Bethlehem,

27 Sammoth the Adi, Chelles the Pheloni,

28 Horai son of Ekke the Thekoi, Abiezer the Anathothi,

29 Sobochai the Asothi, Eli the Ahoi,

30 Moorai the Netophathi, Cholod son of Nooza the Netophathi,

31 Aithi son of Ribai from the hill of Benjamin, Banaias the Pharathoni,

32 Uri from Nachaligaas, Abiel the Garabeththi,

33 Azmoth the Beermi, Eliaba the Salaboni,

34 Bennaias, Hosom the Gennouni, Jonathan son of Sola the Arari,

35 Achim son of Sachar the Arari, Elphal son of Ur,

36 Opher the Mochorathi, Achia the Pheloni,

37 Esrai the Charmali, Naarai son of Azobai,

38 Joel brother of Nathan, Mebaar son of Agari,

39 Selec the Ammonite, Nachor the Berthi, bearer of the gear of Joab son of Sarouia,

40 Ira the Jetheri, Gareb the Jetheri,

41 Urias the Chettite, Zabet son of Achlia,

42 Adina son of Saiza the Reubenite, a ruler, and thirty were with him,

43 Anan son of Moacha and Josaphat the Baithani,

44 Ozia the Astarothi, Samma and Jehiel sons of Chothan the Arari,

45 Jediael son of Samri and Joazae his brother the Ieasi,

46 Eliel the Mii and Jaribi and Josia his son, Elnaam and Jethma the Moabite,

47 Aliel and Obed and Jesiel the Misabia.

Chapter 12

1 And these are those who came to David at Sikelag, while he was still being kept away from before Saul son of Kis; and these were among the mighty men helping in the war,

2 with bow to the right and to the left, and slingers with stones and bows. From the brothers of Saul, from Benjamin:

3 the ruler Achiezer, and Joas son of Asma the Gebothite, and Joel and Jophalelet sons of Asmoth, and Berchia and Jeuel the Anathothi,

4 and Samaia the Gabaonite, mighty among the thirty and over the thirty,

5 Jeremias and Jeziel and Joanan and Jozabad the Gadarathi,

6 Eliazai and Jarimuth and Baalia and Samaria and Saphatia the Charaiphi,

7 Elcana and Jesouni and Ozriel and Joazar and Jesboam the Corites,

8 and Elia and Zabada, sons of Iraam, sons of Gedor. —

9 And from Gad they separated themselves to David from the wilderness, mighty men of strength, men of battle array, carrying shields and spears; their faces were like the face of a lion, and they were swift as gazelles upon the mountains for speed.

10 Azer the ruler, Abdia the second, Eliab the third,

11 Masemannai the fourth, Jeremias the fifth,

12 Eththi the sixth, Eliab the seventh,

13 Joanan the eighth, Eleazar the ninth,

14 Jeremias the tenth, Machabannai the eleventh.

15 These, from the sons of Gad, were commanders of the army, one for a hundred, small, and great for thousands.

16 These crossed the Jordan in the first month, when it had overflowed all its banks; and they drove out all the inhabitants of the valleys from east to west. —

17 And from the sons of Benjamin and Judah they came to David’s aid.

18 And David went out to meet them and said to them, “If you have come to me in peace, may my heart be with you; but if to hand me over to my enemies, when there is no truth in my hand, may the God of our fathers see and reprove.”

19 And a spirit clothed Amasai, ruler of the thirty, and he said, “Go, and your people, David son of Jesse. Peace, peace to you, and peace to your helpers, because your God has helped you.” And David received them and appointed them leaders of the armies. —

20 And from Manasseh some joined David when the foreigners came against Saul for war; but he did not help them, because the rulers of the foreigners took counsel, saying, “At the heads of those men he will return to his lord Saul.”

21 When he went to Sikelag, from Manasseh there joined him Edna and Jozabad and Jodiel and Michael and Josabeth and Elimuth and Selathi; they were commanders of thousands belonging to Manasseh.

22 And they fought together with David against Geddur, because they were all mighty in strength, and were leaders in the army in power.

23 For day by day they came to David for a great force, like a force of God.

24 And these are the names of the commanders of the army, those who came to David at Hebron to turn the kingdom of Saul over to him according to the word of the Lord.

25 Sons of Judah, bearers of shields and bearers of spears, six thousand eight hundred mighty men of battle array.

26 From the sons of Simeon, mighty in strength for battle array, seven thousand one hundred.

27 From the sons of Levi, four thousand six hundred;

28 and Joadae, the leader belonging to Aaron, and with him three thousand seven hundred;

29 and Zadok, a young man mighty in strength, and from his father’s house twenty-two rulers.

30 And from the sons of Benjamin, the brothers of Saul, three thousand; and most of them still kept watch over the house of Saul.

31 And from the sons of Ephraim, twenty thousand eight hundred, mighty in strength, men renowned according to their fathers’ houses.

32 And from half the tribe of Manasseh, eighteen thousand, who were named by name to make David king.

33 And from the sons of Issachar, knowing understanding for the times, knowing what Israel should do for their leaders: two hundred, and all their brothers with them.

34 And from Zebulun, going out in battle array with every weapon of war, fifty thousand, to help David without turning aside.

35 And from Naphtali, one thousand rulers, and with them thirty-seven thousand with shields and spears.

36 And from the Danites, arrayed for war, twenty-eight thousand eight hundred.

37 And from Asher, going out to help in war, forty thousand.

38 And from beyond the Jordan, from Reuben and Gad and half the tribe of Manasseh, with every weapon of war, one hundred twenty thousand.

39 All these were men of war, arranging themselves for battle with a peaceful soul; and they came to Hebron to make David king over all Israel; and the rest of Israel were of one soul to make David king.

40 And they were there three days, eating and drinking, because their brothers had prepared for them.

41 And those neighboring them, as far as Issachar and Zebulun and Naphtali, brought to them on camels and donkeys and mules and calves foods, flour, cakes, raisins, wine and oil, calves and sheep in abundance, because there was joy in Israel.

Chapter 13

1 And David consulted with the commanders of thousands and the commanders of hundreds, with every leader,

2 and David said to the whole assembly of Israel, “If it is good to you, and if it is prospered by the Lord our God, let us send to our brothers who remain in all the land of Israel, and with them the priests, the Levites, in the cities of their possession, and they shall be gathered to us;

3 and let us bring the ark of our God back to us, for they did not seek it from the days of Saul.”

4 And the whole assembly said to do so, because the word was right in the eyes of all the people.

5 And David assembled all Israel from the borders of Egypt and as far as the entrance of Hamath, to bring the ark of God from the city of Jarim.

6 And David brought it up, and all Israel went up to the city of David, which was of Judah, to bring up from there the ark of the Lord God, who sits upon the cherubim, upon which his name was called.

7 And they placed the ark of God upon a new cart from the house of Aminadab, and Oza and his brothers drove the cart.

8 And David and all Israel were playing before God with all their might, and with singers and with lyres and with nablas, with tambourines and with cymbals and with trumpets.

9 And they came as far as the threshing floor, and Oza stretched out his hand to hold the ark, because the calf had turned it aside.

10 And the Lord became angry with anger against Oza and struck him there, because he stretched out his hand upon the ark, and he died there before God.

11 And David was disheartened because the Lord made a breach against Oza, and he called that place Breach of Oza to this day.

12 And David feared God on that day, saying, “How shall I bring the ark of God to myself?”

13 And David did not return the ark to himself, to the city of David, and he turned it aside to the house of Abeddara the Geththite.

14 And the ark of God dwelt in the house of Abeddara three months, and God blessed Abeddaram and all his things.

Chapter 14

1 And Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David, and cedar timbers, and builders of walls, and workers of wood, to build him a house.

2 And David knew that the Lord had prepared him over Israel, because his kingdom was exalted to a height for the sake of his people Israel.

3 And David took still more wives in Jerusalem, and still more sons and daughters were born to David.

4 And these are the names of those born to him, who were in Jerusalem: Sammaa, Isobaam, Nathan, Solomon,

5 and Ibaar and Elisae and Eliphalet,

6 and Nage and Naphag and Janouou,

7 and Elisamae and Balegdae and Eliphalet.

8 And foreigners heard that David had been anointed king over all Israel, and all the foreigners went up to seek David. And David heard and went out to meet them.

9 And foreigners came and gathered in the valley of the giants.

10 And David inquired through God, saying, “Shall I go up against the foreigners, and will you give them into my hands?” And the Lord said to him, “Go up, and I will give them into your hands.”

11 And he went up to Baalpharasin, and David struck them there; and David said, “God broke through my enemies by my hand like a breaking through of water.” For this reason he called the name of that place Breach of Pharasin.

12 And they left their gods there, and David said, “Burn them with fire.” —

13 And foreigners added still more, and gathered again in the valley of the giants.

14 And David inquired again in God, and God said to him, “You shall not go after them; turn away from them, and stand by them near the pear trees.

15 And it shall be, when you hear the sound of the shaking of the tops of the pear trees, then you shall go out to the battle, because God has gone out before you to strike the camp of the foreigners.”

16 And he did as God commanded him, and struck the camp of the foreigners from Gabaon as far as Gazara.

17 And David’s name came to be in all the land, and the Lord gave his fear upon all the nations.

Chapter 15

1 And he made houses for himself in the city of David; and he prepared a place for the ark of God and made a tent for it.

2 Then David said, “It is not for anyone to carry the ark of God except the Levites, because the Lord chose them to carry the ark of the Lord and to minister to him forever.”

3 And David assembled all Israel to Jerusalem to bring up the ark of the Lord to the place which he had prepared for it.

4 And David gathered the sons of Aaron and the Levites.

5 From the sons of Caath: Uriel the ruler and his brothers, one hundred twenty.

6 From the sons of Merari: Asaia the ruler and his brothers, two hundred fifty.

7 From the sons of Gersam: Joel the ruler and his brothers, one hundred fifty.

8 From the sons of Elisaphan: Samaia the ruler and his brothers, two hundred.

9 From the sons of Chebron: Eliel the ruler and his brothers, eighty.

10 From the sons of Oziel: Aminadab the ruler and his brothers, one hundred twelve. —

11 And David called Sadoc and Abiathar the priests, and the Levites Uriel, Asaia, Joel, Samaia, Eliel, Aminadab,

12 and said to them, “You are the rulers of the fathers’ houses of the Levites; sanctify yourselves, you and your brothers, and bring up the ark of the God of Israel to the place which I prepared for it;

13 because, in the former time, when you were not [there], our God broke through among us, because we did not seek him according to judgment.”

14 And the priests and the Levites sanctified themselves to bring up the ark of the God of Israel.

15 And the sons of the Levites took the ark of God as Moses commanded, by the word of God, according to the writing, on carrying poles upon them. —

16 And David said to the rulers of the Levites, “Set their brothers, the singers, with instruments of songs, nablas and citharas and cymbals, to make a loud sound on high with a voice of gladness.”

17 And the Levites appointed Heman son of Joel; from his brothers, Asaph son of Barachia; and from the sons of Merari, his brothers, Ethan son of Kisaios.

18 And with them were their second brothers: Zacharias and Oziel and Semiramoth and Iiel and Oni and Eliab and Banaia and Maasia and Mattathia and Eliphalia and Makenia and Abeddom and Iiel and Ozias, the gatekeepers.

19 And the singers Heman, Asaph, and Ethan were with bronze cymbals, to make them be heard.

20 Zacharias and Oziel, Semiramoth, Iiel, Oni, Eliab, Masaias, Banaia, with nablas upon alamoth;

21 and Mattathias and Eliphalias and Makenias and Abeddom and Iiel and Ozias, with citharas of amasenith, to strengthen.

22 And Chonenia, ruler of the Levites, was ruler of the songs, because he was understanding.

23 And Barachia and Elcana were gatekeepers of the ark.

24 And Sobnia and Josaphat and Nathanael and Amasai and Zacharia and Banai and Eliezer the priests were sounding the trumpets before the ark of God. And Abeddom and Iia were gatekeepers of the ark of God.

25 And David and the elders of Israel and the commanders of thousands were going to bring up the ark of the covenant of the Lord from the house of Abeddom with gladness.

26 And it came to pass, when God strengthened the Levites carrying the ark of the covenant of the Lord, that they sacrificed seven calves and seven rams.

27 And David was girded with a linen garment, and all the Levites carrying the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and the singers, and Chonenias the ruler of the songs of the singers; and upon David was a linen garment.

28 And all Israel were bringing up the ark of the covenant of the Lord with signals and with the voice of a shofar and with trumpets and with cymbals, sounding aloud with nablas and with citharas.

29 And the ark of the covenant of the Lord came as far as the city of David, and Melchol daughter of Saul peered through the window and saw King David dancing and playing, and she despised him in her soul.

Chapter 16

1 And they brought in the ark of God and set it in the midst of the tent which David had pitched for it, and they brought whole burnt offerings and peace offerings before God.

2 And David finished offering whole burnt offerings and peace offerings, and blessed the people in the name of the Lord.

3 And he distributed to every man of Israel, from man to woman, to each one a bread-loaf and a portion.

4 And he appointed before the ark of the covenant of the Lord from the Levites those ministering, raising their voices, giving thanks, and praising the Lord God of Israel:

5 Asaph the leader, and second to him Zacharia, Iiel, Semiramoth, Iiel, Mattathias, Eliab, Banaia, Abeddom, and Iiel, with instruments, nablas and citharas; and Asaph with cymbals, sounding aloud;

6 and Banaia and Oziel the priests with trumpets continually before the ark of the covenant of God.

7 On that day then David appointed at the beginning of praising the Lord by the hand of Asaph and his brothers:

8 Give thanks to the Lord, call upon him in his name, make known among the peoples his deeds;

9 sing to him and hymn to him; recount to all his wonders which the Lord did.

10 Praise in his holy name; the heart seeking his good pleasure shall rejoice.

11 Seek the Lord and be strong; seek his face continually.

12 Remember his wonders which he did, his portents and the judgments of his mouth,

13 o seed of Israel, his servants, sons of Jacob, his chosen ones.

14 He himself is the Lord our God; his judgments are in all the earth.

15 Remembering forever his covenant, his word which he commanded for a thousand generations,

16 which he made with Abraham, and his oath with Isaac;

17 he established it for Jacob as an ordinance, for Israel as an eternal covenant,

18 saying, “To you I will give the land of Chanaan, a measured portion of your inheritance.”

19 When they were very few in number, when they were diminished, and sojourned in it,

20 and they went from nation to nation and from kingdom to another people,

21 he did not allow any man to exercise power over them, and he reproved kings on their account:

22 “Do not touch my anointed ones, and do not act wickedly among my prophets.”

23 Sing to the Lord, all the earth; announce his salvation from day to day.

25 For great is the Lord and exceedingly praiseworthy; he is fearful above all the gods.

26 For all the gods of the nations are idols, and our God made heaven.

27 Glory and praise are before him; strength and boasting are in his place.

28 Give to the Lord, families of the nations; give to the Lord glory and strength.

29 Give to the Lord the glory of his name; take gifts and bring them before him, and worship the Lord in his holy courts.

30 Let all the earth fear before him; let the earth be set right and not be shaken.

31 Let heaven rejoice, and let the earth exult, and let them say among the nations, “The Lord is reigning.”

32 The sea shall roar with its fullness, and the tree of the field and all that is in it;

33 then the trees of the forest shall rejoice before the Lord, because he came to judge the earth.

34 Give thanks to the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

35 And say, “Save us, O God of our salvation, and gather us from among the nations, to praise your holy name and to boast in your praises.”

36 Blessed be the Lord God of Israel from everlasting and unto everlasting; and all the people shall say, “Amen.” And they praised the Lord.

37 And they left Asaph and his brothers there before the ark of the covenant of the Lord, to minister before the ark continually, from day to day;

38 and Abeddom and his brothers, sixty-eight, and Abeddom son of Idithon and Ossa, as gatekeepers.

39 And Sadoc the priest and his brother priests before the tent of the Lord in Bama, which is in Gabaon,

40 to offer whole burnt offerings to the Lord upon the altar of whole burnt offerings continually, morning and evening, and according to all that is written in the law of the Lord, as much as he commanded concerning the sons of Israel by the hand of Moses, the servant of God;

41 and with him Heman and Idithon and the rest chosen by name to praise the Lord, because his mercy is forever,

42 and with them trumpets and cymbals to sound aloud, and instruments of the songs of God; the sons of Idithon were at the gate.

43 And all the people went, each to his own house, and David turned back to bless his house.

Chapter 17

1 And it came to pass, when David dwelt in his house, that David said to Nathan the prophet, “Behold, I dwell in a house of cedar, and the ark of the covenant of the Lord is under hides.”

2 And Nathan said to David, “Do all that is in your soul, because God is with you.” —

3 And it came to pass in that night, and the word of the Lord came to Nathan, saying,

4 “Go and say to David my servant, ‘Thus says the Lord: You shall not build a house for me to dwell in it;

5 for I have not dwelt in a house from the day I brought Israel up until this day, but I was in a tent and in a dwelling.

6 In all the places through which I passed, throughout all Israel, did I ever speak to one tribe of Israel, whom I appointed to shepherd my people, saying, “Why have you not built me a house of cedar?”’

7 And now thus you shall say to my servant David: ‘Thus says the Lord Almighty: I took you from the sheepfold, from behind the flocks, to be a leader over my people Israel;

8 and I was with you in all the places where you went, and I destroyed all your enemies from before you, and I made a name for you like the name of the great ones who are upon the earth.

9 And I will appoint a place for my people Israel and will plant him, and he shall dwell by himself and shall worry no more; and injustice shall no longer continue to humble him as from the beginning,

10 and from the days when I appointed judges over my people Israel, I humbled all your enemies; and I will increase you, and the Lord will build a house for you.

11 And it shall be, when your days are fulfilled and you sleep with your fathers, that I will raise up your seed after you, who shall be from your belly, and I will prepare his kingdom.

12 He himself shall build a house for me, and I will make his throne stand upright forever.

13 I will be a father to him, and he shall be a son to me; and I will not remove my mercy from him, as I removed it from those who were before you.

14 And I will make him firm in my house and in his kingdom forever, and his throne shall be established upright forever.’”

15 According to all these words and according to all this vision, thus Nathan spoke to David. —

16 And King David came and sat before the Lord, and said, “Who am I, Lord God, and who is my house, that you have loved me forever?

17 And these things were small in your sight, O God, and you spoke concerning the house of your servant from afar, and looked upon me as a vision of a man, and exalted me, Lord God.

18 What further will David add to you, to glorify [you]? And you know your servant.

19 And according to your heart you did all this greatness.

20 Lord, there is none like you, and there is none besides you in all that we have heard with our ears.

21 And there is no nation still upon the earth like your people Israel, whom God guided to redeem for himself as a people, to make for himself a great and conspicuous name, to cast out from before your people the nations whom you redeemed from Egypt.

22 And you gave your people Israel to yourself as a people forever, and you, Lord, became their God.

23 And now, Lord, let your word which you spoke to your servant and concerning his house be made firm forever,

24 saying, ‘Lord, Lord Almighty, God of Israel, and the house of David your servant is established before you.’

25 For you, Lord, opened the ear of your servant to build a house for him; for this reason your servant found [occasion] to pray before you.

26 And now, Lord, you are yourself God, and you spoke these good things concerning your servant.

27 And now you began to bless the house of your servant, that it may be forever before you; for you, Lord, blessed it, and bless it forever.

Chapter 18

1 And it came to pass after these things that David struck the foreigners and routed them, and took Geth and its villages from the hand of the foreigners.

2 And he struck Moab, and the Moabites became servants to David, bringing gifts.

3 And David struck Adraazar king of Souba, Hamath, as he went to establish his hand upon the river Euphrates.

4 And David captured from them one thousand chariots and seven thousand horses and twenty thousand foot soldiers; and David dismantled all the chariots, and left one hundred chariots from them.

5 And a Syrian came from Damascus to help Adraazar king of Souba, and David struck among the Syrians twenty-two thousand men.

6 And David placed a garrison in Syria toward Damascus, and the Syrians became servants to David, bringing gifts. And the Lord saved David in all the places where he went.

7 And David took the golden collars which were upon the servants of Adraazar, and brought them to Jerusalem.

8 And from Metabechas and from the chosen cities of Adraazar David took very much bronze; from it Solomon made the bronze sea and the pillars and the bronze vessels.

9 And Thoa king of Hamath heard that David had struck the whole force of Adraazar king of Souba,

10 and he sent Idouram his son to King David to inquire of him about peace and to bless him concerning that which he had fought against Adraazar and struck him, because Thoa was a man at war with Adraazar, and all the vessels of silver and gold.

11 And these David sanctified to the Lord together with the silver and the gold which he took from all the nations, from Idumea and Moab and from the sons of Ammon and from the foreigners and from Amalek.

12 And Abessa son of Sarouia struck Idumea in the valley of salt, eighteen thousand,

13 and he placed garrisons in the valley; and all the Idumeans became servants of David. And the Lord saved David in all the places where he went.

14 And David reigned over all Israel, and he was doing judgment and righteousness for all his people.

15 And Joab son of Sarouia was over the army, and Josaphat son of Achiloud was the record-writer,

16 and Sadoc son of Achitob and Achimelech son of Abiathar were priests, and Sousas was the scribe,

17 and Banaias son of Jodae was over the Chereththi and the Phelethi, and the sons of David were the first successors of the king.

Chapter 19

1 And it came to pass after these things that Naas king of the sons of Ammon died, and Anan his son reigned in his place.

2 And David said, “I will do mercy with Anan son of Naas, as his father did mercy with me.” And David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. And David’s servants came to the land of the sons of Ammon to comfort him.

3 And the rulers of Ammon said to Anan, “Is David not honoring your father before you, because he sent comforters to you? Have his servants not come to you in order to search out and spy out the land?”

4 And Anan took David’s servants and shaved them, and cut away half of their garments up to the upper edge, and sent them away.

5 And they came to report to David about the men, and he sent to meet them, because they were greatly dishonored. And the king said, “Stay in Jericho until your beards grow, and then return.” —

6 And the sons of Ammon saw that the people of David had been shamed; and Anan and the sons of Ammon sent one thousand talents of silver to hire for themselves from Syria of Mesopotamia, and from Syria of Mocha, and from Soba, chariots and horsemen.

7 And they hired for themselves thirty-two thousand chariots, and the king of Mocha and his people; and they came and encamped opposite Maidaba. And the sons of Ammon gathered from their cities and came to wage war.

8 And David heard, and sent Joab and the whole army of the mighty men.

9 And the sons of Ammon went out and arrayed themselves for war by the gate of the city, and the kings who had come encamped by themselves in the plain.

10 And Joab saw that the opposing forces had come to fight against him in front and behind, and he selected from every young man of Israel, and they arrayed themselves opposite the Syrian;

11 and he put the rest of the people in the hand of Abessa his brother, and they arrayed themselves opposite the sons of Ammon.

12 And he said, “If the Syrian prevails over me, you shall be a salvation for me; and if the sons of Ammon prevail over you, I will save you.

13 Be manly, and let us grow strong for our people and for the cities of our God; and the Lord will do what is good in his eyes.”

14 And Joab and the people with him arrayed themselves for war opposite the Syrians, and they fled from him.

15 And the sons of Ammon saw that the Syrians had fled, and they too fled from before Joab and from before Abessa his brother, and came into the city. And Joab came to Jerusalem. —

16 And the Syrian saw that Israel had routed him, and he sent messengers, and they brought the Syrian out from beyond the river; and Sophach, chief general of the force of Adraazar, was before them.

17 And it was reported to David, and he gathered all Israel, and crossed the Jordan, and came upon them and arrayed himself against them; and the Syrian arrayed himself opposite David, and they fought against him.

18 And the Syrian fled from before David, and David killed from among the Syrians seven thousand chariots and forty thousand foot soldiers; and he killed Sophach, chief general of the force.

19 And the servants of Adraazar saw that they had stumbled before Israel, and they made an arrangement with David and served him; and the Syrian was no longer willing to help the sons of Ammon.

Chapter 20

1 And it came to pass in the coming year, at the going out of the kings, that Joab led out the whole force of the army, and they ravaged the land of the sons of Ammon; and he came and encircled Rabbah. And David was sitting in Jerusalem; and Joab struck Rabbah and demolished it.

2 And David took the crown of Molchol their king from his head, and its weight was found to be a talent of gold, and there was a precious stone in it, and it was upon David’s head; and he brought out very many spoils of the city.

3 And he led out the people who were in it, and sawed them with saws and with iron axes; and thus David did to all the sons of Ammon. And David and all his people returned to Jerusalem.

4 And it came to pass after these things that there was still war in Gezer with the foreigners. Then Sobochai the Ousathi struck Saphu from among the sons of the giants and humbled him. —

5 And there was still war with the foreigners. And Ellanan son of Iair struck Leemi, brother of Goliath the Geththite, and the wood of his spear was like a weaver’s shuttle. —

6 And there was still war in Geth, and there was a man exceedingly great, and his fingers were six and six, twenty-four; and this man was a descendant of the giants.

7 And he reproached Israel, and Jonathan son of Samma, brother of David, struck him. —

8 These were born of Rapha in Geth; all were four giants, and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

Chapter 21

1 And an adversary stood in Israel and stirred David up to count Israel.

2 And King David said to Joab and to the rulers of the force, “Go, count Israel from Bersabee and as far as Dan, and bring [the count] to me, and I shall know their number.”

3 And Joab said, “May the Lord add to his people a hundredfold as many as they are, and may the eyes of my lord the king see them. All are servants to my lord. Why does my lord seek this? So that it may not become sin for Israel.”

4 But the word of the king prevailed over Joab. And Joab went out and passed through every border of Israel, and came to Jerusalem.

5 And Joab gave David the number of the mustered people; and all Israel was one million one hundred thousand men drawing the sword, and Judah was four hundred eighty thousand men drawing the sword.

6 But Levi and Benjamin he did not number among them, because the word of the king had prevailed over Joab.

7 And this matter appeared evil before God, and he struck Israel.

8 And David said to God, “I have sinned exceedingly, because I did this thing; and now, please remove the evil of your servant, because I have acted foolishly exceedingly.”

9 And the Lord spoke to Gad, the seer of David, saying,

10 “Go and speak to David, saying, ‘Thus says the Lord: I am raising up three things against you; choose for yourself one of them, and I will do it to you.’”

11 And Gad came to David and said to him, “Thus says the Lord: Choose for yourself

12 either three years of famine, or three months for you to flee from before your enemies, with the sword of your enemies to destroy, or three days of the sword of the Lord and death in the land, with the angel of the Lord destroying in all the inheritance of Israel. And now see what I shall answer the one who sent me with a word.”

13 And David said to Gad, “All three are distressing for me exceedingly. Let me fall, then, into the hands of the Lord, because his compassions are exceedingly many; and into the hands of men I shall certainly not fall.”

14 And the Lord gave death in Israel, and seventy thousand men of Israel fell.

15 And God sent an angel to Jerusalem to destroy it. And as he was destroying, the Lord saw and repented concerning the evil, and said to the destroying angel, “Let it be enough for you; release your hand.” And the angel of the Lord was standing at the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite.

16 And David lifted his eyes and saw the angel of the Lord standing between earth and heaven, and his sword drawn in his hand, stretched out over Jerusalem; and David and the elders, clothed in sackcloth, fell upon their faces.

17 And David said to God, “Was it not I who said to count the people? And I am the one who sinned; doing evil, I did evil. And these sheep, what did they do? Lord God, let your hand be upon me and upon the house of my father, and not upon your people for destruction, O Lord.”

18 And an angel of the Lord said to Gad to say to David that he should go up to set an altar to the Lord at the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite.

19 And David went up according to the word of Gad, which he spoke in the name of the Lord.

20 And Orna turned and saw the king, and four of his sons with him, methachabin; and Orna was threshing wheat.

21 And David came to Orna, and Orna went out from the threshing floor and bowed to David, with his face upon the earth.

22 And David said to Orna, “Give me the place of your threshing floor, and I will build upon it an altar to the Lord. Give it to me for its worthy silver, and the plague shall cease from the people.”

23 And Orna said to David, “Take it for yourself, and let my lord the king do what is good before him. See, I have given the calves for a burnt offering, and the plow and the wagons for wood, and the grain for an offering; I have given everything.”

24 And King David said to Orna, “No, for buying I shall buy it for worthy silver, because I shall certainly not take what is yours for the Lord, to offer a burnt offering to the Lord as a gift.”

25 And David gave to Orna, in his place, six hundred shekels of gold by weight.

26 And David built an altar to the Lord there and brought up whole burnt offerings and peace offerings; and he cried out to the Lord, and he heard him with fire from heaven upon the altar of burnt offering, and consumed the whole burnt offering.

27 And the Lord spoke to the angel, and he put the sword into its sheath. —

28 At that time, when David saw that the Lord had heard him at the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite, he sacrificed there.

29 And the tent of the Lord which Moses made in the wilderness, and the altar of whole burnt offerings, were at that time in Bama, in Gabaon;

30 and David was not able to go before it to seek God, because he hurried away from before the sword of the angel of the Lord.

Chapter 22

1 And David said, “This is the house of the Lord God, and this is the altar for whole burnt offerings for Israel.”

2 And David said to gather all the proselytes in the land of Israel, and he appointed stonecutters to cut dressed stones for building a house for God.

3 And David prepared much iron for the nails of the doors and of the gates and for the pivots, and bronze in abundance, without weight;

4 and cedar timbers without number, because the Sidonians and the Tyrians brought many cedar timbers to David.

5 And David said, “Solomon my son is a tender boy, and the house to be built for the Lord is for greatness on high, for a name and for glory in all the earth; I shall prepare it for him.” And David prepared abundantly before his death. —

6 And he called Solomon his son and commanded him to build the house for the Lord God of Israel.

7 And David said to Solomon, “Child, it came upon my soul to build a house for the name of the Lord God.

8 And the word of the Lord came upon me, saying, ‘You poured out blood in abundance and made great wars; you shall not build a house for my name, because you poured out much blood upon the earth before me.

9 Behold, a son is born to you; he shall be a man of rest, and I will give him rest from all his enemies round about, because Solomon is his name, and I will give peace and quiet upon Israel in his days.

10 He shall build a house for my name, and he shall be a son to me, and I shall be a father to him; and I will make upright the throne of his kingdom in Israel forever.’

11 And now, my son, the Lord shall be with you, and he shall prosper, and you shall build a house for the Lord your God, as he spoke concerning you.

12 But may the Lord give you wisdom and understanding, and strengthen you over Israel, to keep and to do the law of the Lord your God.

13 Then you will prosper, if you keep to do the ordinances and the judgments which the Lord commanded Moses concerning Israel. Be manly and be strong; do not fear or be dismayed.

14 And behold, in my poverty I prepared for the house of the Lord one hundred thousand talents of gold and one thousand thousand talents of silver, and bronze and iron without weight, because it is in abundance; and I prepared wood and stones, and add to these.

15 And with you are many workers: craftsmen and builders of stones, and workers of wood, and everyone skilled in every work.

16 In gold, in silver, in bronze, and in iron there is no number. Rise and do, and may the Lord be with you. —

17 And David commanded all the rulers of Israel to assist Solomon his son,

18 saying, “Is not the Lord with you? And he gave you rest round about, because he gave the inhabitants of the land into your hands, and the land was subdued before the Lord and before his people.

19 Now give your hearts and your souls to seek the Lord your God, and rise and build a sanctuary for the Lord your God, to bring the ark of the covenant of the Lord and the holy vessels of God into the house being built for the name of the Lord.”

Chapter 23

1 And David was old and full of days, and he made Solomon his son king in his place over Israel.

2 And he gathered all the rulers of Israel and the priests and the Levites.

3 And the Levites were counted from thirty years old and above, and their number, by headcount, was thirty-eight thousand men.

4 From these, overseers over the works of the house of the Lord were twenty-four thousand, and scribes and judges were six thousand,

5 and gatekeepers were four thousand, and those praising the Lord with the instruments which he had made to praise the Lord were four thousand. —

6 And David divided them into courses among the sons of Levi: Gedsōn, Caath, and Merari;

7 and Parosom, Edan, and Semee.

8 Sons of Edan: the ruler Iiel, and Zethom, and Joel, three.

9 Sons of Semee: Salomith and Iiel and Aidan, three. These were the rulers of the fathers’ houses belonging to Edan.

10 And the sons of Semee: Ieth and Ziza and Joas and Beria; these were the sons of Semee, four.

11 And Ieth was the ruler, and Ziza the second; and Joas and Beria did not multiply sons, and they became one fathers’ house for one enrollment. —

12 Sons of Caath: Ambram, Issaar, Chebron, Oziel, four.

13 Sons of Ambram: Aaron and Moses. And Aaron was set apart to sanctify the holy of holies, he and his sons forever, to burn incense before the Lord, to minister, and to pray by his name forever.

14 And Moses, the man of God, his sons were called into the tribe of Levi.

15 Sons of Moses: Gersam and Eliezer.

16 Sons of Gersam: Shubael the ruler.

17 And Eliezer had sons: Raabia the ruler; and Eliezer had no other sons. And the sons of Raabia increased greatly.

18 Sons of Issaar: Salomoth the ruler.

19 Sons of Chebron: Idud the ruler, Amadia the second, Oziel the third, Ikemias the fourth.

20 Sons of Oziel: Michas the ruler and Isia the second. —

21 Sons of Merari: Mooli and Mousi. Sons of Mooli: Eleazar and Kis.

22 And Eleazar died, and he had no sons, but only daughters; and the sons of Kis, their brothers, took them.

23 Sons of Mousi: Mooli and Eder and Iarimoth, three. —

24 These are the sons of Levi according to their fathers' houses, the rulers of their fathers' houses according to their enrollment, according to the number of their names, by headcount, doing the works of the service of the house of the Lord from twenty years old and above.

25 For David said, "The Lord God of Israel has given rest to his people, and he has dwelt in Jerusalem forever.

26 And the Levites were not carrying the tent and all its vessels for its service,

27 because in the last words of David the number of the sons of Levi is from twenty years old and above,

28 because he set them under the hand of Aaron to minister in the house of the Lord, over the courts and over the chambers, and over the cleansing of all the holy things, and over the works of the service of the house of God,

29 for the showbread, for the fine flour of the offering, and for the unleavened cakes, and for the frying pan, and for the mixed dough, and for every measure,

30 and to stand in the morning to praise and give thanks to the Lord, and likewise in the evening,

31 and over all the whole burnt offerings brought to the Lord on the Sabbaths and at the new moons and at the feasts, by number, according to the judgment concerning them, continually to the Lord.

32 And they shall keep the watches of the tent of the testimony and the watches of their brothers, the sons of Aaron, to minister in the house of the Lord."

Chapter 24

1 And for the sons of Aaron were divisions: sons of Aaron, Nadab and Abiud, Eleazar and Ithamar.

2 And Nadab and Abiud died before their father, and they had no sons; and Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests.

3 And David divided them, and Sadoc from the sons of Eleazar, and Achimelech from the sons of Ithamar, according to their enrollment, according to their service, according to their fathers’ houses.

4 And sons of Eleazar were found more numerous as rulers of the mighty than sons of Ithamar, and he divided them: for the sons of Eleazar, sixteen rulers of fathers’ houses, and for the sons of Ithamar, eight according to fathers’ houses.

5 And he divided them by lots, these with those, because they were rulers of the holy things and rulers of the Lord among the sons of Eleazar and among the sons of Ithamar.

6 And Samaia son of Nathanael, the scribe from Levi, wrote them before the king and the rulers, and Sadoc the priest and Achimelech son of Abiathar, and the rulers of the fathers’ houses of the priests and of the Levites: one fathers’ house each for Eleazar, and one each for Ithamar. —

7 And the first lot came out for Iarib, for Ideia the second,

8 for Charem the third, for Seorim the fourth,

9 for Melchia the fifth, for Miamin the sixth,

10 for Cos the seventh, for Abia the eighth,

11 for Jesus the ninth, for Sechenia the tenth,

12 for Eliasib the eleventh, for Iakim the twelfth,

13 for Ochophpha the thirteenth, for Isbaal the fourteenth,

14 for Belga the fifteenth, for Emmer the sixteenth,

15 for Chezir the seventeenth, for Aphesse the eighteenth,

16 for Phetaia the nineteenth, for Ezekiel the twentieth,

17 for Jachin the twenty-first, for Gamoul the twenty-second,

18 for Dalaia the twenty-third, for Maasai the twenty-fourth.

19 This was their enrollment according to their service, to enter the house of the Lord according to their judgment, through the hand of Aaron their father, as the Lord God of Israel commanded.

20 And for the remaining sons of Levi: for the sons of Ambram, Shubael; for the sons of Shubael, Iadia.

21 For Raabia, Iesias the ruler.

22 And for Issari, Salomoth; for the sons of Salomoth, Iath.

23 Sons of Iediou: Amadia the second, Iaziel the third, Iocom the fourth.

24 Sons of Oziel: Micha; sons of Micha: Samir.

25 Brother of Micha: Isia; sons of Isia: Zacharia.

26 Sons of Merari: Mooli and Mousi; sons of Ozia, sons of Bonni.

27 Sons of Merari belonging to Ozia: his sons Isoam and Zachour and Abdi.

28 For Mooli, Eleazar and Ithamar; and Eleazar died, and he had no sons.

29 For Kis: sons of Kis, Iramel.

30 And sons of Mousi: Mooli and Eder and Iarimoth. These are the sons of the Levites according to their fathers' houses.

31 And they also took lots, like their brothers the sons of Aaron, before the king and Sadoc and Achimelech and the rulers of the fathers' houses of the priests and the Levites, the patriarchs araab, like his younger brothers.

Chapter 25

1 And David the king and the commanders of the force appointed for the works the sons of Asaph and Heman and Idithon, those speaking forth with citharas and nablas and cymbals. And their number came to be by headcount, as they were working in their works:

2 sons of Asaph: Zachour and Joseph and Nethanias and Erael, sons of Asaph following Asaph the prophet, following the king.

3 For Idithon, sons of Idithon: Godolia and Souri and Isaias and Semei and Asabia and Mattathias, six, with their father Idithon, playing on the cithara, thanksgiving and praise to the Lord.

4 For Heman, sons of Heman: Boukias and Manthanias and Azarael and Shubael and Ierimoth and Ananias and Anani and Eliatha and Godollathi and Romemthi — ōd and Jesbacasa and Mallithi and Othēri and Meazoth;

5 all these were sons of Heman, the one playing for the king in the words of God, to raise up a horn; and God gave Heman fourteen sons and three daughters.

6 All these were with their father, hymn-singing in the house of the Lord with cymbals and nablas and citharas, following the king and Asaph and Idithon and Heman.

7 And their number, with their brothers, those taught to sing to the Lord, everyone understanding, came to two hundred eighty-eight. —

8 And they too cast lots for the courses, for the small and the great, for the skilled and those learning.

9 And the first lot came out for his sons and brothers, for Asaph, for Joseph, Godolia; the second, Henaia, his brothers and sons, twelve;

10 the third, Zachour, his sons and brothers, twelve;

11 the fourth, Jesdri, his sons and brothers, twelve;

12 the fifth, Nethanias, his sons and brothers, twelve;

13 the sixth, Boukias, his sons and brothers, twelve;

14 the seventh, Iseriel, his sons and brothers, twelve;

15 the eighth, Josia, his sons and brothers, twelve;

16 the ninth, Manthanias, his sons and brothers, twelve;

17 the tenth, Semei, his sons and brothers, twelve;

18 the eleventh, Azaria, his sons and brothers, twelve;

19 the twelfth, Asabia, his sons and brothers, twelve;

20 the thirteenth, Shubael, his sons and brothers, twelve;

21 the fourteenth, Mattathias, his sons and brothers, twelve;

22 the fifteenth, Ierimoth, his sons and brothers, twelve;

23 the sixteenth, Ananias, his sons and brothers, twelve;

24 the seventeenth, Jesbacasa, his sons and brothers, twelve;

25 the eighteenth, Anani, his sons and brothers, twelve;

26 the nineteenth, Mellethi, his sons and brothers, twelve;

27 the twentieth, Eliatha, his sons and brothers, twelve;

28 the twenty-first, Ethir, his sons and brothers, twelve;

29 the twenty-second, Godollathi, his sons and brothers, twelve;

30 the twenty-third, Meazoth, his sons and brothers, twelve;

31 the twenty-fourth, Romemthi — ōd, his sons and brothers, twelve.

Chapter 26

1 For divisions of the gates: for the sons of Koreim, Mosollamia son of Kore, from the sons of Abiasaph.

2 And Mosollamia had sons: Zacharia the firstborn, Idiel the second, Zabadas the third, Iethnouel the fourth,

3 Olam the fifth, Joanan the sixth, Eliōenai the seventh.

4 And for Abeddom, sons: Samaia the firstborn, Jozabad the second, Joaa the third, Sochar the fourth, Nathanael the fifth,

5 Amiel the sixth, Issachar the seventh, Phollathi the eighth, because God blessed him.

6 And for Samaia his son, sons were born: sons of the firstborn Rosai, for his fathers’ house, because they were mighty.

7 Sons of Samaia: Gothni and Raphael and Obed and Elzabad and Achiu, mighty sons; Eliou and Sabchia and Isbakom.

8 All these were from the sons of Abeddom, they and their brothers and their sons, doing mightily in the work; all of them, sixty-two, belonging to Abeddom.

9 And for Mosollamia, sons and brothers, eighteen mighty men.

10 And for Osa, from the sons of Merari, sons keeping the office, because he was not a firstborn, and his father made him ruler

11 of the second division; Tablai the third, Zacharia the fourth. All these, sons and brothers of Osa, were thirteen. —

12 These were the divisions of the gatekeepers, for the rulers of the mighty men, courses like their brothers, to minister in the house of the Lord.

13 And they cast lots, for the small and for the great, according to their fathers' houses, for gate and gate.

14 And the lot for the east fell to Salamia and Zacharia; the sons of Joas for Melchia cast lots, and the lot came out for the north;

15 for Abeddom, the south, opposite the house of esefin;

16 for the second; for Osa, westward, after the gate of the chamber of the ascent; watch opposite watch.

17 For the east, six by day; for the north, four by day; for the south, four by day; and for esefin, two;

18 for those relieving [the watch]; and toward the west, four; and at the path, two relieving [the watch].

19 These are the divisions of the doorkeepers, for the sons of Kore and for the sons of Merari.

20 And their brothers the Levites were over the treasures of the house of the Lord and over the treasures of the dedicated things.

21 Sons of Ladan, sons of Gershoni belonging to Ladan, rulers of fathers' houses belonging to Ladan the Gershonite: Iiel.

22 And the sons of Iiel, Zethom and Joel, the brothers, were over the treasures of the house of the Lord.

23 For Ambram and Issaar, Chebron and Oziel:

24 and Shubael, of Gersam, of Moses, was leader over the treasures.

25 And for his brother Eliezer: Raabias his son, and Josaias and Joram and Zechri and Salomoth.

26 This Salomoth and his brothers were over all the treasures of the holy things which David the king and the rulers of the fathers' houses, commanders of thousands and of hundreds and leaders of the force, had consecrated,

27 which he took from the wars and from the spoils, and consecrated from them, so as not to delay the building of the house of God;

28 and over all the holy things of Samuel the prophet and Saul son of Kis and Abennēr son of Ner and Joab son of Sarouia; everything which they consecrated was by the hand of Salomoth and his brothers.

29 For Issaar, Chonenia and his sons were over the outside work for Israel, to write and to judge.

30 For the Chebronite, Asabias and his brothers, mighty sons, one thousand seven hundred, were over the oversight of Israel beyond the Jordan toward the west, for every service of the Lord and work of the king.

31 For the Chebronite: Ioudias was ruler of the Chebronites according to their generations, according to their fathers' houses. In the fortieth year of his reign they were enrolled, and a mighty man was found among them in Jazer of the Gileadite region.

32 And his brothers, mighty sons, were two thousand seven hundred, rulers of fathers' houses; and King David appointed them over the Reubenite and the Gaddite and half the tribe of Manasseh, for every command of the Lord and word of the king.

Chapter 27

1 And the sons of Israel according to their number: rulers of fathers' houses, commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds, and scribes serving the people and every matter of the king according to divisions, for every matter of one entering and going out, month by month, for all the months of the year; one division was twenty-four thousand.

2 And over the first division, for the first month: Iesboam son of Zabdeel; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

3 From the sons of Phares, chief of all the rulers of the force for the first month.

4 And over the division of the second month: Dodia the Echochi; and over his division were twenty-four thousand, rulers of the force.

5 The third, for the third month: Banaias son of Iodae the priest, the ruler; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

6 This Banaias was mightier than the thirty and over the thirty, and over his division was Amizabad his son.

7 The fourth, for the fourth month: Asael brother of Joab, and Zabdias his son and the brothers; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

8 The fifth, for the fifth month: the leader Samaoth the Iesrae; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

9 The sixth, for the sixth month: Oduias son of Ekkes the Thecoite; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

10 The seventh, for the seventh month: Chelles from Phallous, from the sons of Ephraim; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

11 The eighth, for the eighth month: Sobochai the Isathi, the Zarai; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

12 The ninth, for the ninth month: Abiezer from Anathoth, from the land of Benjamin; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

13 The tenth, for the tenth month: Meira from Netophath, the Zarai; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

14 The eleventh, for the eleventh month: Banaias from Pharathon, of the sons of Ephraim; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

15 The twelfth, for the twelfth month: Choldai the Netophathi, the Gothoniel; and over his division were twenty-four thousand.

16 And over the tribes of Israel: for Reuben, Eliezer son of Zechri; for Simeon, Saphatias son of Maacha;

17 for Levi, Hasabias son of Camouel; for Aaron, Sadoc;

18 for Judah, Eliab of the brothers of David; for Issachar, Ambri son of Michael;

19 for Zebulun, Samaia son of Abdiou; for Naphtali, Ierimoth son of Esriel;

20 for Ephraim, Hosea son of Ozias; for half the tribe of Manasseh, Joel son of Phadaia;

21 for half the tribe of Manasseh in Gilead, Iaddai son of Zabdiou; for the sons of Benjamin, Asiel son of Abennēr;

22 for Dan, Azarael son of Ioram. These are the patriarchs of the tribes of Israel. —

23 And David did not take their number from twenty years old and below, because the Lord said to multiply Israel like the stars of heaven.

24 And Joab son of Sarouia began to count among the people and did not finish; and in these things wrath came upon Israel, and the number was not entered in the book of the words of the days of King David.

25 And over the treasures of the king: Asmoth son of Odiel; and over the treasures in the field and in the villages and in the settlements and in the towers: Jonathan son of Ozias.

26 And over those tilling the land, the workers: Esdri son of Chouloub;

27 and over the rural lands: Semee from Rama; and over the treasures of wine in the rural lands: Zachri son of Sephni;

28 and over the olive groves and over the sycamores in the lowland: Balanas the Gedorite; and over the treasures of oil: Joas.

29 And over the cattle grazing in Asidon: Satrais the Sharonite; and over the cattle in the enclosures: Sophat son of Adli;

30 and over the camels: Obil the Ishmaelite; and over the donkeys: Iadias from Merathon;

31 and over the sheep: Iaziz the Agarite. All these were overseers of the possessions of King David. —

32 And Jonathan, David’s father’s brother, was a counselor, a discerning man and himself a scribe; and Iiel son of Achamani was with the sons of the king,

33 and Achitophel was the counselor of the king, and Chousi the first friend of the king,

34 and after this, Achitophel, followed by Jodae son of Banaia and Abiathar; and Joab was chief general of the king.

Chapter 28

1 And David assembled all the rulers of Israel: rulers of judges, and the rulers of the courses around the king’s person, and commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and the treasury keepers, and those over his possessions, and the mighty men and the warriors of the army, in Jerusalem.

2 And David stood in the midst of the assembly and said, “Hear me, my brothers and my people. It came upon my heart to build a house of rest for the ark of the covenant of the Lord, and a standing-place for the feet of the Lord our God; and I prepared the things suitable for the dwelling.

3 And God said, ‘You shall not build a house for me, to call my name upon it, because you are a warrior man and have poured out blood.’

4 And the Lord God of Israel chose me from all the house of my father to be king over Israel forever; and in Judah he chose the kingdom, and from the house of Judah the house of my father; and among the sons of my father, in me he was pleased to make me king over all Israel.

5 And from all my sons [because the Lord gave me many sons] he chose Solomon my son to sit upon the throne of the kingdom of the Lord over Israel.

6 And God said to me, ‘Solomon your son shall build my house and my court, because I have chosen him to be a son to me, and I shall be a father to him;

7 and I will make his kingdom upright forever, if he is strong to keep my commandments and my judgments, as on this day.’

8 And now, before all the assembly of the Lord and in the ears of our God, keep and seek all the commandments of the Lord our God, so that you may inherit the good land and leave it as an inheritance to your sons after you forever.

9 And now, Solomon my son, know the God of your fathers and serve him with a perfect heart and a willing soul, because the Lord examines all hearts and knows every thought. If you seek him, he will be found by you; and if you forsake him, he will forsake you to the end.

10 See now that the Lord chose you to build a house for him as a sanctuary. Be strong and do. —

11 And David gave Solomon his son the plan of the temple and its houses and its zakcho and its upper rooms and its inner storerooms and the house of atonement,

12 and the plan which he had in his spirit, of the courts of the house of the Lord and all the chambers around, for the storerooms of the house of the Lord and the storerooms of the holy things,

13 and the dwellings of the courses of the priests and the Levites for every work of service of the house of the Lord, and the storerooms for the serviceable vessels of the service of the house of the Lord.

14 And the weight of their weighing, both of the gold and of the silver,

15 he gave him the weight of the lampstands and of the lamps;

16 likewise he gave him the weight of the tables of the presentation bread, each golden table, and likewise the silver ones,

17 and of the meat hooks and libation vessels and the golden bowls, and the weight of the gold and silver, kephphoure of each weight.

18 And he showed him the weight of the altar of incense, of tested gold, and the plan of the chariot of the cherubim, with their wings spread out and overshadowing the ark of the covenant of the Lord.

19 David gave everything in writing by the hand of the Lord to Solomon, according to the understanding of the working-out of the plan which had come to him. —

20 And David said to Solomon his son, “Be strong and be manly and do; do not fear or be dismayed, because the Lord my God is with you. He will not release you and will certainly not forsake you until you complete all the work of service of the house of the Lord.

21 And behold, the courses of the priests and the Levites are for every service of the house of God, and with you in every matter is everyone willing in wisdom according to every craft, and the rulers and all the people are for all your words.”

Chapter 29

1 And King David said to the whole assembly, “Solomon my son, the one whom the Lord chose in him, is young and tender, and the work is great, because the building is not for a man, but for the Lord God.

2 According to all my strength I prepared for the house of my God gold, silver, bronze, iron, wood, stones of soom and of filling, and costly and various stones, and every precious stone, and much Parian stone.

3 And still, in my taking pleasure in the house of my God, there is for me what I have acquired, gold and silver; and behold, I have given it to the house of my God for height, apart from what I prepared for the house of the holy things:

4 three thousand talents of gold from Suphir, and seven thousand talents of refined silver, to overlay with them the walls of the temple

5 by the hand of craftsmen. And who is willing today to fill his hands for the Lord?”

6 And the rulers of the fathers’ houses were willing, and the rulers of the sons of Israel, and the commanders of thousands and of hundreds, and the overseers of the works, and the stewards of the king;

7 and they gave for the works of the house of the Lord five thousand talents of gold and ten thousand [pieces] of gold, and ten thousand talents of silver, and eighteen thousand talents of bronze, and one hundred thousand talents of iron.

8 And those among whom a stone was found gave it for the storerooms of the house of the Lord, by the hand of Iiel the Gershonite.

9 And the people rejoiced over the willingness, because with a full heart they willingly offered to the Lord; and King David also rejoiced greatly.

10 And King David blessed the Lord before the assembly, saying, “Blessed are you, Lord God of Israel, our father from everlasting and unto everlasting.

11 Yours, Lord, is the greatness and the power and the boasting and the victory and the strength, because you rule over all things in heaven and upon the earth; before your face every king and nation is troubled.

12 From you are wealth and glory; you rule over all, Lord, ruler of every rule; and in your hand are strength and power, and in your hand, Almighty, are the making great and the strengthening of all.

13 And now, we confess to you and praise the name of your boasting.

14 And who am I, and who is my people, that we were able to be willing for these things? Because all things are yours, and from what is yours we have given to you.

15 Because we are sojourners before you and dwellers, as all our fathers were; like a shadow are our days upon the earth, and there is no endurance.

16 Lord our God, all this abundance which I prepared to build a house for your holy name is from your hand, and all things are yours.

17 And I knew, Lord, that you are the one testing hearts and loving righteousness. In simplicity of heart I willingly offered all these things, and now I saw your people who were found here willingly offering to you with joy.

18 Lord God of Abraham and Isaac and Israel our fathers, keep these things forever in the intention of the heart of your people, and direct their hearts toward you.

19 And to Solomon my son give a good heart to do your commandments and your testimonies and your ordinances, and to bring the construction of your house to completion.

20 And David said to the whole assembly, “Bless the Lord your God.” And the whole assembly blessed the Lord, the God of their fathers, and bending their knees they worshiped the Lord and the king.

21 And David sacrificed sacrifices to the Lord and brought whole burnt offerings to God on the day after the first day: one thousand calves, one thousand rams, one thousand lambs, and their libations, and sacrifices in abundance for all Israel.

22 And they ate and drank before the Lord on that day with joy, and they made Solomon son of David king a second time, and anointed him to the Lord as king and Sadoc as priest.

23 And Solomon sat upon the throne of David his father and was well-pleasing, and all Israel listened to him.

24 The rulers and the mighty men and all the sons of King David his father submitted themselves to him.

25 And the Lord magnified Solomon above before all Israel and gave him the glory of a king, which had not happened upon any king before him.

26 And David son of Iessai reigned over Israel

27 forty years: in Hebron seven years, and in Jerusalem thirty-three years.

28 And he died in a good old age, full of days, wealth, and glory; and Solomon his son reigned in his place.

29 And the remaining words of King David, the former and the later, are written in the words of Samuel the seer, and upon the words of Nathan the prophet, and upon the words of Gad the seer,

30 concerning all his kingdom and his might and the times which came upon him and upon Israel and upon all the kingdoms of the earth.

2 Chronicles

Chapter 1

1 And Solomon son of David was strengthened over his kingdom, and the Lord his God was with him and magnified him on high.

2 And Solomon spoke to all Israel, to the commanders of thousands and to the commanders of hundreds and to the judges and to all the rulers before Israel, the rulers of the fathers' houses,

3 and Solomon and all the assembly with him went to the high place in Gabaon, where there was the tent of the testimony of God, which Moses the servant of the Lord had made in the wilderness;

4 but David had brought up the ark of God from the city of Cariathiarim, because he had prepared a tent for it in Jerusalem,

5 and the bronze altar, which Beseleel son of Uriou son of Hor had made, was there before the tent of the Lord; and Solomon and the assembly sought it,

6 and Solomon brought up there upon the bronze altar before the Lord, the one in the tent, and brought up upon it one thousand whole burnt offerings. —

7 In that night God appeared to Solomon and said to him, "Ask what I shall give you."

8 And Solomon said to God, "You have done great mercy with David my father, and have made me king in his place;

9 and now, Lord God, let your name be established upon David my father, because you have made me king over a numerous people, like the dust of the earth.

10 Now give me wisdom and understanding, and I shall go out before this people and enter in; for who can judge this great people of yours?"

11 And God said to Solomon, "Because this came to be in your heart, and you did not ask for wealth of possessions, or glory, or the life of your adversaries, or many days, but asked for yourself wisdom and understanding, in order to judge my people over whom I made you king,

12 wisdom and understanding I give to you, and wealth and possessions and glory I will give to you, as there has not been one like you among the kings before you, and after you there shall not be such."

13 And Solomon came from the high place in Gabaon to Jerusalem, from before the tent of the testimony, and reigned over Israel.

14 And Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen, and he had one thousand four hundred chariots and twelve thousand horsemen; and he left them in the cities of the chariots, and the people were with the king in Jerusalem.

15 And the king placed the gold and the silver in Jerusalem like stones, and the cedars in Judea like sycamines in the lowland, in abundance.

16 And the going out of Solomon's horses was from Egypt, and the price of the king's merchants; they bought for trade.

17 And they went up and brought out of Egypt one chariot for six hundred pieces of silver, and one horse for one hundred fifty; and thus they brought them in their hands to all the kings of the Hittites and the kings of Syria.

18 And Solomon said to build a house for the name of the Lord and a house for his kingdom.

Chapter 2

1 And Solomon assembled seventy thousand men and eighty thousand stonecutters in the mountain, and the overseers over them were three thousand six hundred. —

2 And Solomon sent to Hiram king of Tyre, saying, “As you did with David my father and sent him cedars to build himself a house to dwell in it,

3 behold, I, his son, am building a house for the name of the Lord my God, to sanctify it to him, to burn incense before him continually, and the presentation continually, and to offer whole burnt offerings continually, morning and evening and on the Sabbaths and at the new moons and at the feasts of the Lord our God; this is forever for Israel.

4 And the house which I am building is great, because our God is great above all gods.

5 And who shall be strong to build a house for him? Because heaven and the heaven of heavens do not bear his glory. And who am I, building a house for him? Is it anything except to burn incense before him?

6 And now send me a wise man who knows how to work in gold and in silver and in bronze and in iron and in purple and in scarlet and in blue, and who knows how to engrave an engraving, with the wise men who are with me in Judah and in Jerusalem, whom David my father prepared.

7 And send me cedar timbers and juniper timbers and fir timbers from Lebanon, because I know that your servants know how to cut timbers from Lebanon; and behold, your servants will go with my servants

8 to prepare for me timbers in abundance, because the house which I am building is great and glorious.

9 And behold, for the workers who cut timbers for food, I have given wheat as gifts to your servants: twenty thousand kors, and twenty thousand kors of barley, and twenty thousand measures of wine, and twenty thousand measures of oil. —

10 And Hiram king of Tyre said in writing and sent to Solomon, “Because the Lord loved his people, he gave you over them as king.”

11 And Hiram said, “Blessed is the Lord God of Israel, who made heaven and earth, who gave to David the king a wise son, knowing understanding and knowledge, who shall build a house for the Lord and a house for his kingdom.

12 And now I have sent you a wise man, knowing understanding, Hiram my father,

13 [his mother from the daughters of Dan, and his father a man of Tyre] who knows how to work in gold and in silver and in bronze and in iron, in stones and in wood, and to weave in purple and in blue and in fine linen and in scarlet, and to engrave engravings and to devise every design, whatever you may give him, with your wise men and the wise men of David my lord, your father.

14 And now, let the wheat and the barley and the oil and the wine which my lord said be sent to his servants.

15 And we will cut timbers from Lebanon according to all your need, and we will bring them on rafts upon the sea to Ioppe, and you will bring them to Jerusalem.” —

16 And Solomon assembled all the proselytes in the land of Israel, after the numbering by which David his father had numbered them, and they were found to be one hundred fifty-three thousand six hundred.

17 And he made from them seventy thousand back-bearers and eighty thousand stonecutters, and three thousand six hundred taskmasters over the people.

Chapter 3

1 And Solomon began to build the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, on Mount Amoria, where the Lord appeared to David his father, at the place which David had prepared on the threshing floor of Orna the Jebusite.

2 And he began to build in the second month, in the fourth year of his kingdom.

3 And these are the things Solomon began to build for the house of God: the length in cubits, the first measurement, was sixty cubits, and the width was twenty cubits.

4 And the ailam in front of the house, its length across the front according to the width of the house was twenty cubits, and its height was one hundred twenty cubits; and he overlaid it inside with pure gold.

5 And he paneled the great house with cedar timbers and overlaid it with pure gold, and carved upon it palms and hanging ornaments.

6 And he adorned the house with precious stones for glory, and with gold, gold from Pharouaim;

7 and he gilded the house and the walls and the gates and the ceilings and the doors with gold, and carved cherubim upon the walls. —

8 And he made the house of the holy of holies; its length, across the front according to the width, was twenty cubits, and its width was twenty cubits; and he overlaid it with pure gold, for the cherubim, to six hundred talents.

9 And the weight of the nails, the weight of each one, was fifty shekels of gold. And he gilded the upper room with gold.

10 And he made in the house of the holy of holies two cherubim, wooden work, and gilded them with gold.

11 And the wings of the cherubim were twenty cubits in length; one wing was five cubits, touching the wall of the house, and the other wing was five cubits, touching the wing of the other cherub;

12 and the wing of the one cherub was five cubits, touching the wall of the house, and the other wing was five cubits, touching the wing of the other cherub;

13 and the wings of the cherubim were spread out for twenty cubits; and they were standing upon their feet, and their faces were toward the house.

14 And he made the veil of blue and purple and scarlet and fine linen, and wove cherubim in it. —

15 And he made in front of the house two pillars, thirty-five cubits in height, and their capitals were five cubits.

16 And he made serseroth in the debir and gave them upon the capitals of the pillars; and he made one hundred pomegranates and placed them upon the hanging ornaments.

17 And he set the pillars in front of the temple, one on the right and one on the left; and he called the name of the one on the right Uprightness, and the name of the one on the left Strength.

Chapter 4

1 And he made the bronze altar: twenty cubits in length, and its width twenty cubits, and its height ten cubits.

2 And he made the cast sea, ten cubits across its diameter, round all around; and its height was five cubits, and its circumference was thirty cubits.

3 And a likeness of calves was beneath it; they went around it in a circle; ten cubits encompassed the basin all around. Two kinds cast the calves in its casting,

4 by which they made them: twelve calves, three facing north and three facing west and three facing south and three facing east; and the sea was upon them above, and their backs were inward.

5 And its thickness was a palm, and its lip was like the lip of a cup, engraved with lily shoots; it held three thousand measures. And he finished it.

6 And he made ten lavers and placed five on the right and five on the left, to wash in them the works of the whole burnt offerings and to rinse in them. And the sea was for the priests to wash themselves in it.

7 And he made ten golden lampstands according to their ordinance and placed them in the temple, five on the right and five on the left.

8 And he made ten tables and placed them in the temple, five on the right and five on the left. And he made one hundred golden bowls.

9 And he made the court of the priests and the great court and doors for the court, and their doorways overlaid with bronze.

10 And he placed the sea at the right corner of the house, eastward, opposite.

11 And Hiram made the meat hooks and the firepans and the grate of the altar and all its vessels. And Hiram finished making all the work which he made for King Solomon in the house of God:

12 two pillars, and upon them golath at the chothareth, upon the heads of the two pillars; and two networks to cover the capitals of the chothareth which are upon the heads of the pillars,

13 and four hundred golden bells for the two networks, and two kinds of pomegranates in the one network, to cover the two golath of the chothareth which are above the pillars.

14 And he made ten mechonoth, and he made the lavers upon the mechonoth,

15 and one sea, and the twelve calves beneath it,

16 and the footstands and the analemptēras and the cauldrons and the meat hooks and all their vessels, which Hiram made and brought to King Solomon in the house of the Lord, of pure bronze.

17 In the region of the Jordan the king cast them, in the thickness of the earth, in the house of Sokchoth and between Sirdatha.

18 And Solomon made all these vessels in very great abundance, because the weighing of the bronze did not cease.

19 And Solomon made all the vessels of the house of the Lord and the golden altar and the tables [and upon them the presentation bread],

20 and the lampstands and the lamps for the light according to the ordinance, and before the debir, of pure gold,

21 and their tongs and their lamps and the bowls and the censers and the firepans, of pure gold;

22 and the inner door of the house to the holy of holies, and the doors of the house of the temple, were gold.

Chapter 5

1 And all the work which Solomon did in the house of the Lord was completed. And Solomon brought in the holy things of David his father, the silver and the gold and the vessels, and put them into the treasury of the house of the Lord.

2 Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel and all the rulers of the tribes, the leaders of the fathers’ houses of the sons of Israel, to Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of the covenant of the Lord from the city of David [this is Zion];

3 and all the men of Israel assembled to the king at the feast [this is the seventh month],

4 and all the elders of Israel came, and all the Levites took the ark,

5 and they brought up the ark and the tent of the testimony and all the holy vessels which were in the tent; the priests and the Levites brought them up.

6 And King Solomon and all the assembly of Israel and those fearing and those gathered with them before the ark were sacrificing calves and sheep which could not be numbered and could not be counted because of the multitude.

7 And the priests brought the ark of the covenant of the Lord to its place, to the debir of the house, into the holy of holies, beneath the wings of the cherubim;

8 and the cherubim had spread out their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its carrying poles from above.

9 And the poles projected, and the heads of the poles were visible from the holy place toward the front of the debir; they were not visible outside. And they were there until this day.

10 There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets which Moses placed in Choreb, which the Lord established with the sons of Israel when they came out of the land of Egypt.

11 And it came to pass, when the priests went out from the holy place — because all the priests who were found had been sanctified, and they were not assigned according to a course —

12 and all the Levite singers, the sons of Asaph, Heman, and Idithoun, and their sons and their brothers, clothed in linen garments, were standing with cymbals and nablas and citharas opposite the altar, and with them one hundred twenty priests blowing trumpets,

13 and there was one voice when they trumpeted and when they sang and raised their voice with one voice, to give thanks and praise to the Lord — and when they raised their voice with trumpets and with cymbals and with the instruments of songs, and said, “Give thanks to the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever,” the house was filled with the cloud of the glory of the Lord;

14 and the priests were not able to stand to minister because of the cloud, because the glory of the Lord filled the house of God.

Chapter 6

1 Then Solomon said: The Lord said to dwell in gloom;

2 And I have built a house for your name, holy to you and ready to dwell forever.

3 And the king turned his face and blessed all the assembly of Israel, and all the assembly of Israel was standing by.

4 And he said, “Blessed is the Lord God of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to David my father, and with his hands fulfilled, saying:

5 From the day on which I brought my people up from the land of Egypt, I did not choose a city from all the tribes of Israel to build a house for my name to be there, and I did not choose a man to be ruler over my people Israel;

6 and I chose in David, so as to be over my people Israel.

7 And it came upon the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of the Lord God of Israel,

8 and the Lord said to David my father, “Because it came upon your heart to build a house for my name, you did well, because it came upon your heart;

9 nevertheless, you shall not build the house, because your son, who will come forth from your loins, he shall build the house for my name.

10 And the Lord raised up his word, which he spoke, and I came to be in place of David my father and sat upon the throne of Israel, as the Lord spoke, and I built the house for the name of the Lord God of Israel

11 and I placed there the ark, in which there is the covenant of the Lord, which he made with Israel.

12 And he stood before the altar of the Lord, before all the assembly of Israel, and spread out his hands,

13 because Solomon had made a bronze base and set it in the midst of the court of the sanctuary, its length five cubits and its breadth five cubits and its height three cubits, and he stood upon it and fell upon his knees before all the assembly of Israel and spread out his hands toward heaven

14 and he said, “O Lord God of Israel, there is no God like you in heaven or upon the earth, keeping the covenant and the mercy for your servants, those who walk before you with a whole heart.

15 What you kept for your servant David my father, what you spoke to him saying, and you spoke with your mouth and fulfilled with your hands, as this day.

16 And now, O Lord God of Israel, keep for your servant David my father what you spoke to him, saying, “A man shall not be lacking to you from before me, sitting upon the throne of Israel, except if your sons keep their way to walk in my law, as you walked before me.”

17 And now, O Lord God of Israel, let your word, then, be made certain, which you spoke to your servant David.

18 For will God truly dwell with human beings upon the earth? If the heaven and the heaven of heaven do not suffice you, then what is this house which I built?

19 And may you look upon the prayer of your servant and upon my petition, O Lord God, to give ear to the petition and to the prayer which your servant prays before you today,

20 for your eyes to be open upon this house day and night, upon this place which you said your name would be called upon there, to hear the prayer which your servant prays toward this place.

21 And may you hear the petition of your servant and of your people Israel, whatever they may pray toward this place, and you hear in the place of your dwelling from heaven, and hear and be gracious. —

22 If a man sins against his neighbor, and he takes a curse against him to curse him, and he comes and curses before the altar in this house,

23 and you hear from heaven and act and judge your servants, to repay the lawless one and repay his ways upon his own head, to justify the righteous, to repay him according to his righteousness. —

24 And if your people Israel are shattered before the enemy, if they sin against you, and turn back and confess to your name and pray and make petition before you in this house,

25 and you hear from heaven and be gracious to the sins of your people Israel, and turn them back to the land which you gave to them and to their fathers. —

26 when the heaven is shut up and there is no rain, because they will sin against you, and they pray toward this place and praise your name and turn from their sins, because you will humble them,

27 and you hear from heaven and be gracious to the sins of your servants and of your people Israel, because you will show them the good way in which they will walk in it, and give rain upon your land which you gave to your people as an inheritance. —

28 famine, if it should happen upon the land; death, if it should happen; wind destruction and jaundice; locust and caterpillar, if they should happen; if the enemy afflicts him before their cities, according to every plague and every pain,

29 and every prayer and every petition which may happen to any human and to all your people Israel, if a man knows his touch and his weakness and spreads out his hands toward this house,

30 and you hear from heaven, from your prepared dwelling place, and be propitious, and give to a man according to his ways, as you may know his heart, because you alone know the heart of the sons of humans,

31 so that they may fear all your ways all the days which they themselves live upon the face of the land which you gave to our fathers. —

32 And every foreigner, who is not himself from your people Israel, and comes from a distant land because of your great name and your strong hand and your lifted arm, and they come and pray toward this place,

33 and you hear from heaven, from your prepared dwelling place, and do according to all things whatever the foreigner calls upon you for, so that all the peoples of the earth may know your name and fear you as your people Israel, and know that your name has been called upon this house which I built. —

34 But if your people go out to war against their enemies on the way by which you send them, and they pray to you toward the direction of this city, which you chose in it, and of the house which I built for your name,

35 and you hear from heaven their petition and their prayer and do their judgment. —

36 Because they will sin against you [because there will not be a human who will not sin] and you will strike them and give them over before enemies, and those taking them captive will take them captive into the land of enemies, into a land far or near

37 and they turn their heart in their land, where they were deported there, and indeed they turn and make petition to you in their captivity, saying, “We have sinned, we have acted unjustly, we have acted lawlessly,”

38 and they turn toward you with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of those who took them captive, and pray toward the way of their land, which you gave to their fathers, and of the city which you chose, and of the house which I built for your name,

39 and you hear from heaven, from your prepared dwelling place, their prayer and their petition, and do judgments and be gracious to the people who have sinned against you. —

40 Now, O Lord, let your eyes then be open and your ears attentive to the petition of this place.

41 And now arise, O Lord God, to your resting place, you and the ark of your strength. May your priests, O Lord God, be clothed with salvation, and may your sons rejoice in good things.

42 O Lord God, do not turn away the face of your anointed; remember the mercies of David your servant.

Chapter 7

1 And when Solomon completed praying, fire came down from heaven and consumed the burnt offerings and the sacrifices, and the glory of the Lord filled the house.

2 And the priests were not able to enter into the house of the Lord at that time, because the glory of the Lord filled the house.

3 And all the sons of Israel saw the fire coming down, and the glory of the Lord upon the house, and they fell upon their faces upon the earth, upon the stone pavement, and worshiped and praised the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

4 And the king and all the people were sacrificing sacrifices before the Lord.

5 And Solomon sacrificed the sacrifice of twenty-two thousand young bulls and one hundred twenty thousand livestock, and the king and all the people inaugurated the house of God.

6 And the priests were standing at their watches, and the Levites with the instruments of the songs of the Lord of David the king, for giving thanks before the Lord, because forever is his mercy, with the hymns of David through their hand; and the priests were blowing with the trumpets opposite them, and all Israel was standing.

7 And Solomon sanctified the middle of the court which is in the house of the Lord; because he made there the burnt offerings and the fats of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar which Solomon made did not suffice to receive the burnt offerings and the manaa and the fats.

8 And Solomon held the feast at that time for seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great assembly, from the entrance of Hamath and as far as the torrent of Egypt.

9 And he made a closing assembly on the eighth day, because he made the dedication of the altar a feast for seven days.

10 And on the twenty-third of the seventh month he sent the people to their tents, rejoicing and with a good heart over the good things which the Lord did to David and to Solomon and to Israel his people.

11 And Solomon completed the house of the Lord and the house of the king; and all that Solomon desired in his soul to do in the house of the Lord and in his house prospered.

12 And God appeared to Solomon by night and said to him, “I have heard your prayer and have chosen for myself in this place as a house of sacrifice.

13 If I shut up the heaven and there is no rain, and if I command the locust to eat the tree, and if I send death among my people,

14 and if my people are ashamed, upon whom my name has been called, upon them, and they pray and seek my face and turn away from their evil ways, then I will hear from heaven and will be gracious to their sins and will heal their land.

15 Now my eyes will be open and my ears attentive to the prayer of this place.

16 And now I have chosen and sanctified this house for my name to be there forever, and my eyes and my heart will be there all the days.

17 And you, if you walk before me as David your father and do according to all that I commanded you and guard my ordinances and my judgments,

18 and I will raise up the throne of your kingdom, as I covenanted with David your father, saying, “A man ruling in Israel shall not be removed from you.”

19 And if you yourselves turn away and abandon my ordinances and my commandments which I gave before you, and go and serve other gods and worship them,

20 and I will take you out from the land which I gave to them, and this house, which I sanctified for my name, I will turn away from before my face, and I will give it as a parable and as a narrative among all the nations.

21 And this house, the high one, everyone passing by it will be astonished and will say, “For what reason did the Lord do this to this land and to this house?”

22 And they will say, “Because they abandoned the Lord, the God of their fathers, who brought them out from the land of Egypt, and took hold of other gods and worshiped them and served them; because of this he brought upon them all this evil.”

Chapter 8

1 And it came to pass after twenty years, in which Solomon built the house of the Lord and his own house,

2 and the cities which Hiram gave to Solomon, Solomon built them and settled the sons of Israel there.

3 And Solomon came to Aimath Soba and strengthened it.

4 And he built Thedmor in the wilderness and all the fortified cities which he built in Emath.

5 And he built Baithoron the Upper and Baithoron the Lower, fortified cities, walls, gates, and bars,

6 and Baalath and all the fortified cities which belonged to Solomon, and all the cities of the chariots and the cities of the horsemen, and whatever Solomon desired according to the desire to build in Jerusalem and in Lebanon and in all his kingdom.

7 All the people who remained from the Hittite and the Amorite and the Perizzite and the Hivite and the Jebusite, who are not from Israel —

8 They were from their sons, those left after them in the land, whom the sons of Israel did not destroy — and Solomon brought them up as tribute until this day.

9 And from the sons of Israel Solomon did not give any as servants for his kingdom, because they were men of war and rulers and mighty men and leaders of chariots and horsemen.

10 And these were chiefs of the overseers of King Solomon; two hundred and fifty taskmasters among the people.

11 And Solomon brought the daughter of Pharaoh up from the city of David to the house which he built for her, because he said, “My wife shall not dwell in the city of David, king of Israel, because it is holy, where the ark of the Lord entered there.”

12 Then Solomon offered whole burnt offerings to the Lord upon the altar which he built in front of the sanctuary,

13 and according to the word of each day for offering, according to the commands of Moses, on the Sabbaths and on the months and on the feasts three times of the year: on the feast of unleavened things and on the feast of weeks and on the feast of tents.

14 And he set in order, according to the judgment of David, the divisions of the priests according to their services, and the Levites at their watches, to praise and to minister before the priests according to the word of the day, day by day, and the gatekeepers according to their divisions, at gate and gate, because thus are the commands of David, man of God;

15 They did not pass beyond the commands of the king concerning the priests and the Levites in every matter and in the treasuries.

16 And all the work was prepared from the day on which it was founded until Solomon completed the house of the Lord.

17 Then Solomon went to Gasiongaber and to Ailath, by the seaside in the land of Idumaea.

18 And Hiram sent ships and servants who knew the sea by the hand of his servants, and they went with the servants of Solomon to Sophira and took from there four hundred and fifty talents of gold and came to King Solomon.

Chapter 9

1 And the queen of Saba heard the name of Solomon and came to test Solomon with riddles in Jerusalem with a very heavy force, and camels carrying spices and gold in great quantity and a precious stone; and she came to Solomon and spoke to him all that was in her heart.

2 And Solomon declared to her all her words, and no word passed from Solomon which he did not declare to her.

3 And the queen of Saba saw the wisdom of Solomon and the house which he built,

4 and the food of the tables and the seating of his servants and the standing of his ministers and their clothing and his cupbearers and their adornment and the burnt offerings which he offered in the house of the Lord, and she came to be outside herself.

5 And she said to the king, “True was the word which I heard in my land about your words and about your wisdom,

6 and I did not believe the words until I came and my eyes saw, and behold, half of the abundance of your wisdom was not reported to me; you have added upon the hearing which I heard;

7 blessed are the men, blessed are these your servants who are standing before you continually and hearing your wisdom;

8 let the Lord your God be blessed, who desired to give you upon his throne as king for the Lord your God; because the Lord your God loved Israel to establish it forever, and gave you over them as king to do judgment and righteousness.”

9 And she gave the king one hundred twenty talents of gold and spices in great quantity and a precious stone; and there had not been like those spices which the queen of Saba gave to King Solomon.

10 [And the servants of Solomon and the servants of Hiram were bringing gold to Solomon from Sophir and pine wood and precious stone;

11 and the king made the pine wood into stairs for the house of the Lord and for the house of the king, and citharas and nablas for the singers, and such things had not been seen before in the land of Juda.]

12 And King Solomon gave Queen Saba all her desires which she asked, besides all that she brought to King Solomon; and she returned to her land.

13 And the weight of the gold brought to Solomon in one year was six hundred sixty-six talents of gold,

14 except for that of the men subordinated and those trading, from whom they brought, and all the kings of Arabia and the satraps of the land were bringing gold and silver to King Solomon.

15 And King Solomon made two hundred large beaten gold shields, six hundred pure gold for one shield; six hundred gold were laid upon the one shield;

16 and three hundred beaten gold shields, three hundred gold were brought upon each shield; and the king gave them in the house of the forest of Lebanon.

17 And the king made a great throne of elephant teeth, and overlaid it with tested gold;

18 and six steps were to the throne, bound with gold, and armrests here and there upon the throne of the seat, and two lions standing beside the armrests,

19 and twelve lions standing there upon the six steps, here and there; it did not come to be so in every kingdom.

20 And all the vessels of King Solomon were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were covered with gold; silver was not accounted for anything in the days of Solomon;

21 because a ship for the king went to Tharsis with the servants of Hiram; once through three years ships came from Tharsis for the king, filled with gold and silver and ivory teeth and apes.

22 And Solomon was magnified above all the kings both in wealth and in wisdom.

23 And all the kings of the earth were seeking the face of Solomon to hear his wisdom, which God gave in his heart.

24 And they were each bringing his gifts: vessels of silver and vessels of gold and clothing, stacte and spices, horses and mules, year by year.

25 And there were for Solomon four thousand female horses for chariots and twelve thousand horsemen, and he placed them in the cities of the chariots and with the king in Jerusalem.

26 And he was ruling over all the kings from the river and as far as the land of the foreigners and as far as the boundary of Egypt.

27 And the king gave the gold and the silver in Jerusalem as stones, and the cedars as sycamores which are in the plain, in great quantity.

28 And the export of the horses from Egypt for Solomon and from all the land.

29 And the remaining words of Solomon, the first and the last, behold, they are written in the words of Nathan the prophet and in the words of Achia the Selonite and in the visions of Ioel the seer concerning Ieroboam son of Nabat.

30 And Solomon the king reigned over all Israel forty years.

31 And Solomon slept, and they buried him in the city of David his father, and Roboam his son reigned in his place.

Chapter 10

1 And Roboam came to Sychem, because all Israel was coming to Sychem to make him king.

2 And it came to pass, when Ieroboam son of Nabat heard — and he himself was in Egypt, as he fled from before King Solomon and Ieroboam dwelt in Egypt — Ieroboam returned from Egypt.

3 And they sent and called him, and Ieroboam and all the assembly of Israel came to Roboam, saying,

4 “Your father made our yoke hard, and now release us from the hard service of your father and from his heavy yoke, which he put upon us, and we will serve you.”

5 And he said to them, “Go for three days and come to me”; and the people went away.

6 And King Roboam gathered the elders who had stood before Solomon his father while he was alive, saying, “How do you counsel to answer this people with a word?”

7 And they spoke to him, saying, “If today you are good to this people and please them and speak good words to them, they will be servants to you all the days.”

8 And he left behind the counsel of the elders who counseled him, and counseled with the young men who had been brought up with him, those who stood before him.

9 And he said to them, “What do you counsel, and I shall answer a word to this people who spoke to me, saying, ‘Ease us from the yoke which your father put upon us?’”

10 And the young men who had been brought up with him spoke to him: “Thus you shall speak to the people who spoke to you, saying, ‘Your father made our yoke heavy, and you, release us from it’; thus you shall say, ‘My little finger is thicker than the loins of my father;

11 and now my father disciplined you with a heavy yoke, and I will add upon your yoke; my father disciplined you with whips, and I will discipline you with scorpions.’”

12 And Ieroboam and all the people came to Roboam on the third day, as the king spoke, saying, “Return to me on the third day.”

13 And the king answered harshly, and King Roboam abandoned the counsel of the elders

14 and he spoke to them according to the counsel of the younger men, saying, “My father made your yoke heavy, and I will add upon it; my father disciplined you with whips, and I will discipline you with scorpions.”

15 And the king did not listen to the people, because a turning was from God, saying, The Lord raised up his word, which he spoke by the hand of Achia the Selonite concerning Ieroboam son of Nabat

16 and all Israel, because their king did not listen. And the people answered the king, saying, “What portion is there for us in David, and inheritance in the son of Iessai? To your tents, Israel; now see to your house, David.” And all Israel went to their tents;

17 And the men of Israel who dwelt in the cities of Juda, and Roboam reigned over them.

18 And King Roboam sent Adoniram, the one over the tribute, and the sons of Israel stoned him with stones and he died; and King Roboam hurried to go up upon the chariot to flee to Jerusalem.

19 And Israel rejected the house of David until this day.

Chapter 11

1 And Roboam came to Jerusalem and assembled Juda and Benjamin, one hundred eighty thousand young men making war, and he fought against Israel to turn the kingdom to Roboam.

2 And the word of the Lord came to Samaias, a man of God, saying,

3 Say to Roboam son of Solomon and to all Juda and Benjamin, saying,

4 “Thus says the Lord: You shall not go up and you shall not fight against your brothers; each of you, return to his house, because this word came from me.” And they heeded the word of the Lord and turned back from going against Ieroboam.

5 And Roboam dwelt in Jerusalem and built walled cities in Judaia.

6 and he built Baithleem and Aitam and Thekoe

7 and Baithsoura and Sochchoth and Odollam

8 and Geth and Marisan and Ziph

9 and Adoraim and Lachis and Azeika

10 and Saraa and Aialon and Chebron, which belongs to Juda and Benjamin, walled cities.

11 And he fortified them with walls and gave in them leaders and stores of provisions, oil and wine,

12 according to city and according to city, shields and spears, and he strengthened them exceedingly much; and Juda and Benjamin were his. —

13 And the priests and the Levites, who were in all Israel, gathered to him from all the borders;

14 because the Levites abandoned the dwellings of their possession and went to Juda, to Jerusalem, because Ieroboam and his sons cast them out so that they would not minister to the Lord,

15 and he set up for himself priests of the high places and for the idols and the vanities and the calves which Ieroboam made,

16 and he cast them out from the tribes of Israel, those who gave their heart to seek the Lord God of Israel, and they came to Jerusalem to sacrifice to the Lord God of their fathers

17 And they strengthened the kingdom of Juda and strengthened Roboam son of Solomon for three years, because he walked in the ways of David and Solomon for three years.

18 And Roboam took for himself as wife Mollath, daughter of Ierimouth son of David, Abaia daughter of Eliab the Iessai,

19 and she bore to him sons: Iaous and Samarian and Roollam.

20 and after these things he took for himself Maacha daughter of Abessalom, and she bore to him Abia and Ieththi and Ziza and Emmoth.

21 And Roboam loved Maacha daughter of Abessalom above all his wives and his concubines, because he had eighteen wives and thirty concubines; and he begot twenty-eight sons and sixty daughters.

22 And Roboam appointed Abia son of Maacha as ruler, to be leader among his brothers, because he intended to make him king;

23 and he grew beyond all his sons in all the borders of Juda and Benjamin and in the fortified cities, and gave them a great abundance of provisions and requested a multitude of wives.

Chapter 12

1 And it came to pass when the kingdom of Roboam was prepared and when it was established, he abandoned the commandments of the Lord, and all Israel with him.

2 And it came to pass in the fifth year of the reign of Roboam, Sousakim king of Egypt went up against Jerusalem, because they had sinned before the Lord,

3 with one thousand two hundred chariots and sixty thousand horses, and there was no number of the multitude that came with him from Egypt: Libyans, Troglodytes, and Ethiopians.

4 And they seized the fortified cities that were in Juda, and he came to Jerusalem.

5 And Samaias the prophet came to Roboam and to the rulers of Juda, who had gathered in Jerusalem from before Sousakim, and said to them, “Thus said the Lord: You have abandoned me, and I will abandon you into the hand of Sousakim.”

6 And the rulers of Israel and the king were ashamed and said, “The Lord is righteous.”

7 And when the Lord saw that they were ashamed, the word of the Lord came to Samaias, saying, “They have been ashamed; I will not utterly destroy them, and I will give them a little for salvation, and by no means will my anger drip in Jerusalem,

8 because they shall be servants, and they shall know my service and the service of the kingdom of the earth.”

9 And Sousakim king of Egypt went up and took the treasures that were in the house of the Lord and the treasures that were in the house of the king; he took everything; and he took the golden shields which Solomon made,

10 and Roboam made bronze shields instead of them. And Sousakim appointed over him leaders of runners, those guarding the gate of the king;

11 And it came to pass, when the king entered the house of the Lord, the guards and the runners and those returning went in to meet the runners.

12 And when he was humbled, the wrath of the Lord turned away from him, and not to destruction at the end; for there were good words in Juda.

13 And Roboam strengthened himself in Jerusalem and reigned; Roboam was forty-one years old when he reigned, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, in the city which the Lord chose to name his name there from all the tribes of the sons of Israel; and the name of his mother was Noomma the Ammanite.

14 And he did the evil, because he did not direct his heart to seek the Lord.

15 And the first and last words of Roboam, are they not, behold, written in the words of Samaias the prophet and of Addo the seer, and his deeds? And Roboam was warring against Ieroboam all the days.

16 And Roboam died and was buried with his fathers, and was buried in the city of David, and Abia his son reigned in his place.

Chapter 13

1 In the eighteenth year of the reign of Ieroboam, Abia reigned over Juda;

2 he reigned three years in Jerusalem, and the name of his mother was Maacha, daughter of Uriel from Gabaon. And there was war between Abia and between Ieroboam.

3 And Abia arrayed the battle with a force of mighty warriors, four hundred thousand mighty men, and Ieroboam arrayed against him the battle with eight hundred thousand, mighty warriors of force.

4 And Abia stood up from Mount Somoron, which is in Mount Ephraim, and said: Hear, Ieroboam and all Israel.

5 Is it not for you to know that the Lord God of Israel gave the kingdom over Israel forever to David and to his sons, a covenant of salt?

6 And Ieroboam son of Nabat, the servant of Solomon son of David, rose up and rebelled against his lord.

7 And worthless men, sons of lawlessness, gathered to him and stood against Roboam son of Solomon; and Roboam was younger and cowardly in heart and did not stand before him.

8 And now you say you yourselves are standing against the kingdom of the Lord by the hand of the sons of David; and you are a great multitude, and with you are golden calves which Ieroboam made for you as gods.

9 Have you not cast out the priests of the Lord, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and made yourselves priests from the people of the land? Everyone approaching to fill the hands with a calf from the cattle and seven rams becomes a priest to what is not God.

10 But we have not abandoned the Lord our God, and his priests, the sons of Aaron and the Levites, minister to the Lord in their courses;

11 they make smoke for the Lord: whole burnt offerings morning and evening, and compound incense, and the presentations of bread upon the pure table, and the golden lampstand and the lamps of burning, to kindle in the evening, because we keep the watches of the Lord God of our fathers, and you have abandoned him.

12 And behold, with us at the head is God and his priests and the trumpets of signaling to signal against you. Sons of Israel, you will fight against the Lord God of our fathers, because it will not prosper for you. —

13 And Ieroboam turned the ambush to come from behind them; and it came to be before Juda, and the ambush from behind.

14 And Juda turned, and behold, the battle was before them and from behind, and they shouted to the Lord, and the priests sounded the trumpets.

15 And the men of Juda shouted, and it came to pass while the men of Juda were shouting that the Lord struck Ieroboam and Israel before Abia and Juda.

16 And the sons of Israel fled from before Juda, and the Lord delivered them into their hands.

17 And Abia and his people struck a great blow among them, and wounded men fell from Israel: five hundred thousand mighty men.

18 And the sons of Israel were humbled on that day, and the sons of Juda were strengthened, because they hoped upon the Lord God of their fathers.

19 And Abia pursued after Ieroboam and took cities from him in advance: Baithēl and its villages, and Isana and its villages, and Ephron and its villages.

20 And Ieroboam had no more strength all the days of Abia, and the Lord struck him, and he died.

21 And Abia strengthened himself and took for himself fourteen wives, and begot twenty-two sons and sixteen daughters.

22 And the remaining words of Abia and his deeds and his words are written upon the book of the prophet Addo.

23 And Abia died with his fathers, and they buried him in the city of David, and Asa his son reigned in his place. In the days of Asa, the land of Juda was quiet for ten years.

Chapter 14

1 And he did the good and the straight before the Lord his God.

2 And he removed the altars of the foreign ones and the high places, and broke the pillars and cut down the groves

3 and said to Juda to seek the Lord God of their fathers and to do the law and the commandments.

4 And he removed from all the cities of Juda the altars and the idols. And he had peace;

5 walled cities in the land of Juda, because the land had peace; and there was no war for him in these years, because the Lord gave him rest.

6 And he said to Juda, “Let us build these cities and make walls and towers and gates and bars, in which we shall rule over the land, because as we sought the Lord our God, he sought us and gave us rest round about and prospered us.”

7 And there was for Asa a force of arms-bearers carrying shields and spears, in the land of Juda three hundred thousand, and in the land of Benjamin peltasts and archers, two hundred and fifty thousand; all these were warriors of force.

8 And Zare the Ethiopian went out against them with a force, with a thousand thousands and three hundred chariots, and came as far as Marisa.

9 And Asa went out to meet him and arrayed battle in the valley to the north of Marisa.

10 And Asa cried to the Lord his God and said, “Lord, it is not impossible with you to save with many and with few; strengthen us, Lord our God, because on you we have trusted and upon your name we came against this great multitude; Lord our God, let not a man prevail against you.”

11 And the Lord struck the Ethiopians before Juda, and the Ethiopians fled;

12 and Asa and his people pursued them as far as Gedor, and the Ethiopians fell, so that there was no preservation among them, because they were crushed before the Lord and before his force; and they plundered much spoil.

13 And they cut down their villages around Gedor, because a terror of the Lord came upon them, and they plundered all their cities, because much spoil came to them;

14 and indeed tents of possessions, the Amazoneans, they cut down, and took many sheep and camels and returned to Jerusalem.

Chapter 15

1 And Azarias son of Oded, the spirit of the Lord came upon him,

2 and he went out to meet Asa and all Juda and Benjamin and said, “Hear me, Asa and all Juda and Benjamin; the Lord is with you when you are with him, and if you seek him, he will be found for you, and if you abandon him, he will abandon you.

3 And many days for Israel with no true God, and no priest teaching, and with no law;

4 and it will turn to the Lord God of Israel, and he will be found for them.

5 And in that time there is no peace for the one going out and for the one coming in, because a terror of the Lord is upon all who dwell in the lands.

6 And nation will fight against nation and city against city, because God astounded them in every affliction.

7 And you, be strong, and do not let your hands grow slack, because there is a reward for your labor.” –

8 And upon hearing these words and the prophecy of Adad the prophet, he strengthened himself and cast the abominations out from all the land of Juda and Benjamin and from the cities which he had captured in Mount Ephraim, and dedicated the altar of the Lord which was before the temple of the Lord.

9 And he assembled Juda and Benjamin and the proselytes who were resident with him from Ephraim and from Manasse and from Symeon, because many of Israel had been added to him when they saw that the Lord his God was with him.

10 And they gathered to Jerusalem in the third month, in the fifteenth year of the reign of Asa.

11 And he sacrificed to the Lord on that day from the spoils which they had brought: seven hundred calves and seven thousand sheep.

12 And he passed into a covenant to seek the Lord God of their fathers with all the heart and with all the soul;

13 and everyone who should not seek the Lord God of Israel shall die, from younger to older, from man to woman.

14 And they swore by the Lord with a great voice and with trumpets and with horns.

15 And all Juda rejoiced over the oath, because with all the soul they swore and with every willingness they sought him, and he was found for them, and the Lord gave them rest round about. –

16 And Maacha his mother he removed from serving Astarte, and he cut down the idol and burned it in the torrent of Kedron.

17 Except the high places did not depart; they still existed in Israel; but the heart of Asa became full all his days.

18 And he brought in the holy things of David his father and the holy things of the house of the Lord God: silver and gold and vessels.

19 And there was no war with him until the thirty-fifth year of the reign of Asa.

Chapter 16

1 And in the thirty-eighth year of the reign of Asa, Baasa king of Israel went up against Juda and built Rama, so as not to give an exit and an entrance to Asa king of Juda.

2 And Asa took gold and silver from the treasures of the house of the Lord and of the king’s house and sent to the son of Ader king of Syria, who dwelt in Damascus, saying,

3 “Make a covenant between me and you and between my father and your father; behold, I have sent you gold and silver; come and scatter Baasa king of Israel away from me, and let him depart from me.”

4 And the son of Ader heard king Asa and sent the rulers of his force against the cities of Israel and struck Ion and Dan and Abelmain and all the surrounding regions of Nephthali.

5 And it came to pass, when Baasa heard, he left off building Rama any longer and stopped his work.

6 And Asa the king took all Juda and took the stones of Rama and its timbers, which Baasa had built, and built with them Gabae and Maspha. –

7 And at that time Anani the prophet came to Asa king of Juda and said to him, “Because you have trusted in the king of Syria and have not trusted in the Lord your God, for this reason the force of Syria escaped from your hand.

8 Were not the Ethiopians and Libyans a great force in courage, in horsemen an exceedingly great multitude? And when you trusted in the Lord, he delivered into your hands.

9 For the eyes of the Lord look upon all the earth, to strengthen with every heart full toward him. You have acted ignorantly in this; from now on there will be war with you.”

10 And Asa became angry with the prophet and placed him in prison, because he was enraged at this; and Asa maltreated among the people at that time.

11 And behold, the words of Asa, the first and the last, are written in the book of the kings of Juda and Israel.

12 And Asa became diseased in his feet in the thirty-ninth year of his reign, until he was exceedingly diseased; and in his disease he did not seek the Lord, but the physicians.

13 And Asa slept with his fathers and died in the thirty-ninth year of his reign,

14 and they buried him in the tomb which he dug for himself in the city of David, and laid him on the bed and filled with spices and kinds of ointments of perfumers and made for him an exceedingly great funeral procession.

Chapter 17

1 And Josaphat his son reigned in his stead, and Josaphat grew strong against Israel.

2 And he placed a force in all the fortified cities of Juda and appointed leaders in all the cities of Juda and in the cities of Ephraim which Asa his father had previously taken.

3 And the Lord was with Josaphat, because he walked in the first ways of his father and did not seek the idols,

4 but sought the Lord, the God of his father, and walked in the commandments of his father, and not according to the works of Israel.

5 And the Lord established the kingdom in his hand, and all Juda gave gifts to Josaphat, and he had wealth and much glory.

6 And his heart was exalted in the way of the Lord, and he further removed the high places and the groves from the land of Juda.

7 And in the third year of his reign he sent his leaders and the sons of the mighty, Abdias and Zacharias and Nathanael and Michaias, to teach in the cities of Juda,

8 and with them the Levites Samouias and Nathanias and Zabdias and Asiel and Semiramoth and Jonathan and Adonias and Tobias, the Levites, and with them Elisama and Joram the priests,

9 and they taught in Juda, and with them was a book of the law of the Lord, and they went through the cities of Juda and taught the people.

10 And a terror of the Lord came upon all the kingdoms of the land around Juda, and they did not wage war against Josaphat;

11 and from the foreigners they brought Josaphat gifts and silver and presents, and the Arabs brought him seven thousand seven hundred rams of sheep.

12 And Josaphat went on becoming greater unto a height, and built dwellings in Judea and fortified cities.

13 And he had many works in Judea and mighty warriors, strong in Jerusalem.

14 And this was their number according to the houses of their families: for Juda, commanders of thousands, Ednas the ruler, and with him three hundred thousand mighty sons of force;

15 and after him Joanan the leader, and with him two hundred and eighty thousand;

16 and after him Amasias, the son of Zachri, who was eager for the Lord, and with him two hundred thousand mighty men of force.

17 And from Benjamin, a mighty man of force, Eliada, and with him two hundred thousand archers and peltasts;

18 and after him Jozabad, and with him a hundred and eighty thousand mighty men of war.

19 These were those serving the king, besides those whom the king placed in the fortified cities in all Judea.

Chapter 18

1 And Josaphat still had wealth and much glory, and he allied himself by marriage in the house of Achaab.

2 And at the end of years he went down to Achaab in Samaria, and Achaab sacrificed many sheep and calves for him and for the people with him, and deceived him into going up with him to Ramoth of Galaaditis.

3 And Achaab king of Israel said to Josaphat king of Juda, “Will you go with me to Ramoth of Galaaditis?” And he said to him, “As I, so also you; as your people, also my people with you for war.”

4 And Josaphat said to the king of Israel, “Seek the Lord today, then.”

5 And the king of Israel gathered the prophets, four hundred men, and said to them, “Shall I go to Ramoth Galaad for war, or hold back?” And they said, “Go up, and God will give into the hands of the king.”

6 And Josaphat said, “Is there not yet a prophet of the Lord here, and we shall inquire of him?”

7 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat, “There is yet one man through whom to seek the Lord, and I have hated him, because he is not prophesying good concerning me, because all his days are for evil; this is Michaias son of Jemla.” And Josaphat said, “Let not the king speak thus.”

8 And the king of Israel called one eunuch and said, “Quickly, Michaias son of Jemla.”

9 And the king of Israel and Josaphat king of Juda were sitting, each upon his throne, and clothed in robes, sitting in the broad space at the door of the gate of Samaria, and all the prophets were prophesying before them.

10 And Sedekias son of Chanana made himself iron horns and said, “Thus says the Lord: With these you will gore Syria until it is brought to an end.”

11 And all the prophets were prophesying thus, saying, “Go up to Ramoth Galaad and you will be prospered, and the Lord will give into the hands of the king.”

12 And the messenger who went to call Michaias spoke to him, saying, “Behold, the prophets have spoken good concerning the king with one mouth, and let your words, then, be as one of theirs, and you shall speak good.”

13 And Michaias said, “The Lord lives, that whatever God should say to me, that I shall speak.”

14 And he came to the king, and the king said to him, “Michaias, shall I go to Ramoth Galaad for war, or hold back?” And he said, “Go up and you will prosper, and they will be given into your hands.”

15 And the king said to him, “How many times do I adjure you that you speak to me only truth in the name of the Lord?”

16 And he said, “I saw Israel scattered in the mountains as sheep that have no shepherd, and the Lord said, ‘They have no leader; let them return, each to his house in peace.’”

17 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat, “Did I not tell you that he does not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?”

18 And he said, “Not so; hear a word of the Lord: I saw the Lord sitting upon his throne, and all the force of heaven stood at his right and at his left.

19 And the Lord said, ‘Who will deceive Achaab king of Israel, and he will go up and fall in Ramoth Galaad?’ And this one spoke thus, and this one spoke thus.

20 And the spirit came out and stood before the Lord and said, ‘I will deceive him.’ And the Lord said, ‘With what?’

21 And he said, ‘I will go out and be a false spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.’ And he said, ‘You will deceive and will be able; go out and do thus.’

22 And now behold, the Lord has put a false spirit in the mouth of all these prophets of yours, and the Lord has spoken evil against you.”

23 And Sedekias son of Chanana drew near and struck Michaias on the jaw and said to him, “By what way did the spirit of the Lord pass from me to speak to you?”

24 And Michaias said, “Behold, you will see on that day on which you enter a chamber from a chamber to hide yourself.”

25 And the king of Israel said, “Take Michaias and send him back to Emer ruler of the city and to Joas the ruler, the son of the king,

26 and you shall say, ‘Thus said the king: Put this one in a house of imprisonment, and let him eat bread of affliction and water of affliction until I return in peace.’”

27 And Michaias said, “If returning you return in peace, the Lord has not spoken in me; hear, all peoples.”

28 And the king of Israel and Josaphat king of Juda went up to Ramoth Galaad.

29 And the king of Israel said to Josaphat, “I will cover myself and enter the war, and you put on my clothing”; and the king of Israel covered himself and entered the war.

30 And the king of Syria commanded the rulers of the chariots who were with him, saying, “Do not fight the small and the great, but only the king of Israel.”

31 And it came to pass, when the rulers of the chariots saw Josaphat, they said, “He is the king of Israel,” and surrounded him to fight; and Josaphat cried out, and the Lord saved him, and God turned them away from him.

32 And it came to pass, when the rulers of the chariots saw that he was not the king of Israel, they turned away from him.

33 And a man drew a bow with good aim and struck the king of Israel between the lung and the breastplate. And he said to the charioteer, “Turn your hand and take me out of the war, because I have been hurt.”

34 And the battle was turned to flight on that day, and the king of Israel stood upon the chariot until evening opposite Syria and died as the sun was setting.

Chapter 19

1 And Josaphat king of Juda returned to his house in peace, to Jerusalem.

2 And Ju, the son of Anani, the prophet, went out to meet him and said to him, “King Josaphat, do you help a sinner, or befriend one hated by the Lord? For this reason wrath from the Lord came upon you;

3 but good words were found in you, because you removed the groves from the land of Juda and directed your heart to seek the Lord.”

4 And Josaphat dwelt in Jerusalem and again went out to the people from Bersabee as far as Mount Ephraim and turned them to the Lord God of their fathers.

5 And he appointed judges in all the fortified cities of Juda, in city after city,

6 and said to the judges, “See what you are doing, because you judge for the Lord, not for man, and with you are the words of the judgment;

7 and now let the fear of the Lord come upon you, and keep watch and you shall act, because with the Lord our God there is no injustice, nor admiration of a face, nor taking of gifts.”

8 For also in Jerusalem Josaphat appointed from the priests and the Levites and the patriarchs of Israel for the judgment of the Lord and to judge those dwelling in Jerusalem.

9 And he commanded them, saying, “Thus you shall act in the fear of the Lord, in truth and with a full heart;

10 every man, the judgment coming upon you from your brothers dwelling in their cities, between blood and blood and between ordinance and commandment and statutes and judgments, and you shall give them directions, and they will not sin against the Lord, and there will be no wrath upon you and upon your brothers; thus you shall act and will not sin.

11 And behold, Amarias the priest is leader over you for every word of the Lord, and Zabdias son of Ismael, the leader for the house of Juda, for every word of the king, and the scribes and the Levites before your face; be strong and act, and the Lord will be with the good.”

Chapter 20

1 And after these things the sons of Moab and the sons of Ammon, and with them some of the Minaeans, came against Josaphat for war.

2 And they came and informed Josaphat, saying, “A great multitude has come against you from beyond the sea, from Syria, and behold, they are in Asasanthamar [this is Engaddi].”

3 And he was afraid, and Josaphat set his face to seek the Lord and proclaimed a fast in all Juda.

4 And Juda gathered to seek the Lord, and from all the cities of Juda they came to seek the Lord.

5 And Josaphat stood in the assembly of Juda in Jerusalem, in the house of the Lord, before the new court,

6 and said, “Lord God of our fathers, are you not God in heaven, and you rule all the kingdoms of the nations, and in your hand is strength of dominion, and it is not possible to stand against you?

7 Are you not the Lord who destroyed those dwelling in this land from before your people Israel and gave it to the seed of Abraham your beloved forever?

8 And they dwelt in it and built in it a sanctuary for your name, saying,

9 ‘If evils come upon us, sword, judgment, death, famine, we shall stand before this house and before you, because your name is upon this house, and we shall cry to you out of affliction, and you will hear and save.’

10 And now behold, the sons of Ammon and Moab and Mount Seir, among whom you did not allow Israel to pass through them when they came out of the land of Egypt, because they turned aside from them and did not destroy them,

11 and now behold, they attempt to come out against us, to cast us out of our inheritance which you gave us.

12 Lord our God, will you not judge among them? Because we have no strength to stand against this great multitude that has come against us, and we do not know what we should do to them, but our eyes are upon you.”

13 And all Juda stood before the Lord, and their children and the women. –

14 And for Oziel, the son of Zacharias, of the sons of Banaias, of the sons of Eleel, of Manthanias the Levite, from the sons of Asaph, the spirit of the Lord came upon him in the assembly,

15 and he said, “Hear, all Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem and king Josaphat; thus says the Lord to you yourselves: Do not fear nor be terrified before this great crowd, because the battle belongs to God, not to you.

16 Tomorrow go down against them; behold, they are coming up by the ascent of Asas, and you will find them at the end of the river of the wilderness of Jeriel.

17 It is not for you to fight; understand these things and see the salvation of the Lord with you, Juda and Jerusalem; do not fear nor be terrified to go out tomorrow to meet them, and the Lord is with you.” –

18 And Josaphat bowed upon his face, and all Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem fell before the Lord to worship the Lord.

19 And the Levites from the sons of Kaath and from the sons of Kore stood up to praise the Lord God of Israel with a great voice on high.

20 And they rose early in the morning and went out to the wilderness of Thekoe, and as they went out Josaphat stood and cried out and said, “Hear me, Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem; trust in the Lord your God, and you will be trusted; trust in his prophet, and you will be prospered.”

21 And he took counsel with the people and appointed psalm-singers and those praising to give thanks and praise the holy things as they went out before the force, and they said, “Give thanks to the Lord, because his mercy is forever.”

22 And when his praise of thanksgiving began, the Lord caused the sons of Ammon to fight against Moab and Mount Seir, those who had come out against Juda, and they were routed.

23 And the sons of Ammon and Moab rose against those dwelling on Mount Seir to destroy and wipe out; and when they made an end of those dwelling in Seir, they rose against one another to be destroyed.

24 And Juda came to the lookout of the wilderness and looked and saw the multitude, and behold, all were dead, fallen upon the ground; there was none escaping.

25 And Josaphat and his people came to plunder their spoils and found many cattle and baggage and spoils and desirable vessels, and plundered for themselves, and they spent three days plundering the spoils, because they were many.

26 And on the fourth day they gathered in the valley of blessing, for there they blessed the Lord; for this reason they called the name of that place Valley of Blessing until this day.

27 And every man of Juda returned to Jerusalem, and Josaphat leading them, with great gladness, because the Lord gladdened them on account of their enemies,

28 and they entered Jerusalem with nablas and lyres and trumpets, into the house of the Lord.

29 And a terror of the Lord came upon all the kingdoms of the earth when they heard that the Lord fought against the adversaries of Israel.

30 And the kingdom of Josaphat had peace, and his God gave him rest round about.

31 And Josaphat reigned over Juda, thirty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Azouba daughter of Sali.

32 And he walked in the ways of his father Asa and did not turn aside from doing the straight before the Lord;

33 but the high places still existed, and still the people did not direct their heart toward the Lord God of their fathers.

34 And the remaining words of Josaphat, the first and the last, behold, are written in the words of Ju the son of Anani, who wrote down a book of the kings of Israel.

35 And after these things Josaphat king of Juda joined with Ochozias king of Israel [and this one acted lawlessly]

36 in acting and going to him to make ships to go to Tharsis, and he made ships in Gasiongaber.

37 And Eliezer, the son of Dodias, from Marisa, prophesied against Josaphat, saying, “As you befriended Ochozias, the Lord shattered your work, and your ships were broken.” And he was unable to go to Tharsis.

Chapter 21

1 And Josaphat slept with his fathers and was buried beside his fathers in the city of David, and Joram his son reigned in his stead.

2 And he had six brothers, sons of Josaphat: Azarias and Jiel and Zacharias and Azarias and Michael and Saphatias; all these were sons of Josaphat king of Juda.

3 And their father gave them many gifts, silver and gold and arms, with walled cities in Juda; and he gave the kingdom to Joram, because this one was the firstborn.

4 And Joram rose over his kingdom and became strong and killed all his brothers with a sword, and some of the rulers of Israel.

5 When he was thirty-two years old, Joram was established over his kingdom, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem.

6 And he walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as the house of Achaab did, because a daughter of Achaab was his wife, and he did the evil before the Lord.

7 And the Lord was unwilling to destroy the house of David because of the covenant which he made with David, and as he told him to give a lamp to him and to his sons all the days.

8 In those days Edom revolted from Juda, and they made a king reign over themselves.

9 And Joram went with the rulers, and all the cavalry with him; and it came to pass, he rose by night and struck Edom who surrounded him and the rulers of the chariots, and the people fled to their dwellings.

10 And Edom revolted from Juda until this day; then Lomna revolted at that time from his hand, because he abandoned the Lord God of his fathers.

11 For he also made high places in the cities of Juda and caused those dwelling in Jerusalem to commit fornication and led Juda astray.

12 And a writing came to him from Elias the prophet, saying, “Thus says the Lord, the God of David your father: Because you did not walk in the way of Josaphat your father and in the ways of Asa king of Juda,

13 and walked in the ways of the kings of Israel and caused Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem to commit fornication, as the house of Achaab caused fornication, and killed your brothers, the sons of your father, who were better than you,

14 behold, the Lord will strike you with a great blow among your people and among your sons and among your wives and among all your baggage,

15 and you with an evil disease, with a disease of the belly, until your bowels come out with the disease from days to days.”

16 And the Lord stirred up against Joram the foreigners and the Arabs and the neighbors of the Ethiopians,

17 and they went up against Juda and oppressed and carried away all the baggage which they found in the king’s house, and his sons and his daughters, and no son was left to him except Ochozias, the youngest of his sons.

18 And after all these things the Lord struck him in the belly with a disease in which there is no healing;

19 and it came to pass from days to days, and when the time of the days came, two days, his bowels came out with the disease, and he died with an evil disease. And his people did not make a funeral procession as the funeral procession of his fathers.

20 He was thirty-two years old when he became king, and he reigned eight years in Jerusalem; and he went away without praise and was buried in the city of David and not in the tombs of the kings.

Chapter 22

1 And those dwelling in Jerusalem made Ochozias his young son reign in his stead, because the band of robbers that came upon them, the Arabs and the Alimazoneans, killed all the older ones; and Ochozias son of Joram king of Juda reigned.

2 Ochozias became king when he was twenty years old, and he reigned one year in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Gotholia daughter of Ambri.

3 And this one walked in the way of the house of Achaab, because his mother was a counselor to sin;

4 and he did the evil before the Lord as the house of Achaab, because after his father died they were counselors to him to destroy him,

5 and he walked in their counsels. And he went with Joram son of Achaab for war against Azael king of Syria to Rama Galaad; and the archers struck Joram.

6 And Joram returned to Jezrael to be healed from the wounds with which the Syrians struck him in Rama when he fought against Azael king of Syria; and Ochozias son of Joram king of Juda went down to see Joram son of Achaab in Jezrael, because he was ill.

7 And from God came the downfall of Ochozias in coming to Joram; and when he came, Joram went out with him to Ju son of Namessi, the Lord’s anointed, the house of Achaab.

8 And it came to pass, when Ju avenged the house of Achaab, he found the rulers of Juda and the brothers of Ochozias serving Ochozias and killed them.

9 And he said to seek Ochozias, and they caught him being treated in Samaria and brought him to Ju, and he killed him. And they buried him, because they said, “He is a son of Josaphat, who sought the Lord with all his heart.” And there was none in the house of Ochozias to strengthen a force concerning the kingdom.

10 And Gotholia the mother of Ochozias saw that her son had died, and rose and destroyed all the seed of the kingdom in the house of Juda.

11 And Josabeth the king’s daughter took Joas son of Ochozias and stole him from among the king’s sons who were being put to death and placed him and his nurse in the chamber of the beds; and Josabeth, daughter of king Joram, sister of Ochozias, wife of Jodae the priest, hid him and hid him from the face of Gotholia, and she did not kill him.

12 And he was with her in the house of God, hidden for six years, and Gotholia reigned over the land.

Chapter 23

1 And in the seventh year Jodae strengthened himself and took the commanders of hundreds, Azarias son of Joram and Ismael son of Joanan and Azarias son of Obed and Maasaias son of Adaias and Elisaphan son of Zacharias, with him into a house.

2 And they went around Juda and gathered the Levites from all the cities of Juda and rulers of the families of Israel, and came to Jerusalem.

3 And all the assembly of Juda made a covenant in the house of God with the king, and he showed them the king’s son and said to them, “Behold, let the king’s son reign, as the Lord spoke concerning the house of David.

4 Now this is the matter which you shall do: let a third of you, of the priests and the Levites, enter on the sabbath, and into the gates of the entrances,

5 and a third in the king’s house, and a third in the middle gate, and all the people in the courts of the house of the Lord.

6 And let none enter the house of the Lord except the priests and the Levites and those serving of the Levites; they shall enter, because they are holy, and let all the people keep the watches of the Lord.

7 And the Levites shall surround the king round about, a man’s weapon in his hand, and the one entering the house shall die; and they shall be with the king as he enters and goes out.”

8 And the Levites and all Juda did according to all that Jodae the priest commanded, and each took his men from the beginning of the sabbath until the departure of the sabbath, because Jodae did not dismiss the divisions.

9 And he gave the swords and the shields and the arms which belonged to king David in the house of God.

10 And he stationed all the people, each with his arms, from the right flank of the house as far as the left flank of the altar and the house, around the king.

11 And he brought out the king’s son and put upon him the crown and the testimonies, and Jodae and his sons made him king and anointed him and said, “Let the king live.”

12 And Gotholia heard the voice of the people running and giving thanks and praising the king, and entered to the king in the house of the Lord.

13 And she saw, and behold, the king at his station, and at the entrance the rulers and the trumpets around the king, and all the people rejoiced and sounded the trumpets, and the singers with the instruments, singing and hymning praise; and Gotholia tore her robe and cried out and said, “Attacking, you attack.”

14 And Jodae the priest went out, and Jodae the priest commanded the commanders of hundreds and the leaders of the force and said to them, “Cast her outside the house and go in behind her, and let her die by a sword”; because the priest said, “Let her not die in the house of the Lord.”

15 And they gave her room, and she went through the gate of the horsemen of the king’s house, and they put her to death there. –

16 And Jodae made a covenant between himself and the people and the king, to be a people for the Lord.

17 And all the people of the land entered the house of Baal and tore it down, and pulverized his altars and idols, and put Matthan the priest of Baal to death before his altars.

18 And Jodae the priest entrusted the works of the house of the Lord through the hand of priests and Levites and established the divisions of the priests and the Levites which David appointed over the house of the Lord, and to offer whole burnt offerings to the Lord, as it is written in the law of Moses, with gladness and with songs through the hand of David.

19 And the gatekeepers stood at the gates of the house of the Lord, and none unclean in any matter shall enter.

20 And he took the patriarchs and the mighty men and the rulers of the people and all the people of the land, and they brought the king up into the house of the Lord, and he entered through the inner gate into the king’s house, and they seated the king upon the throne of the kingdom.

21 And all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet; and they put Gotholia to death with a sword.

Chapter 24

1 Joas was seven years old when he became king, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Sabia from Bersabee.

2 And Joas did the straight before the Lord all the days of Jodae the priest.

3 And Jodae took two wives for him, and he begot sons and daughters.

4 And it came to pass after these things, and it came upon the heart of Joas to repair the house of the Lord.

5 And he gathered the priests and the Levites and said to them, “Go out to the cities of Juda and gather silver from all Israel to strengthen the house of the Lord year by year, and hasten to speak”; and the Levites did not hasten.

6 And king Joas called Jodae the ruler and said to him, “Why did you not attend to the Levites to bring in from Juda and Jerusalem what was determined by Moses the man of God, when he assembled Israel for the tent of testimony?

7 For Gotholia was the lawless one, and her sons tore down the house of God, for they also used the holy things of the house of the Lord for the Baalim.”

8 And the king said, “Let a chest be made and let it be placed outside at the gate of the house of the Lord;

9 and let them proclaim in Juda and in Jerusalem to bring in for the Lord, as Moses the servant of God said concerning Israel in the wilderness.”

10 And all the rulers and all the people gave, and brought in and cast into the chest until it was filled.

11 And it came to pass, as they brought the chest to the king’s overseers through the hand of the Levites, and as they saw that the silver had increased, the king’s scribe and the overseer of the great priest came and emptied the chest and set it in its place; thus they did day by day and gathered much silver.

12 And the king and Jodae the priest gave it to those doing the works for the work of the house of the Lord, and they hired stonecutters and carpenters to repair the house of the Lord, and smiths of iron and bronze to repair the house of the Lord.

13 And those doing the works worked, and the extent of the works increased in their hands, and they restored the house of the Lord to its standing and strengthened it.

14 And when they finished, they brought the remainder of the silver to the king and to Jodae, and made vessels for the house of the Lord, vessels for the service of whole burnt offerings and gold and silver censers. And they offered whole burnt offerings in the house of the Lord continually, all the days of Jodae.

15 And Jodae grew old, full of days, and died, being a hundred and thirty years old when he died;

16 and they buried him in the city of David with the kings, because he did goodness with Israel and with God and his house.

17 And it came to pass after the death of Jodae, the rulers of Juda entered and bowed down to the king; then the king listened to them.

18 And they abandoned the Lord God of their fathers and served the Astartes and the idols; and wrath came upon Juda and upon Jerusalem on this day.

19 And he sent prophets to them to turn to the Lord, and they did not hear; and they testified to them, and they did not hear.

20 And the spirit of God clothed Azarias, the son of Jodae, the priest, and he stood above the people and said, “Thus says the Lord: Why do you pass by the commandments of the Lord? And you will not be prospered, because you abandoned the Lord, and he will abandon you.”

21 And they attacked him and stoned him by the command of Joas the king in the court of the house of the Lord.

22 And Joas did not remember the mercy which Jodae his father did with him, and put his son to death. And as he was dying, he said, “May the Lord see, and let him judge.”

23 And it came to pass after the completion of the year, a force of Syria went up against him and came against Juda and against Jerusalem and destroyed all the rulers of the people among the people, and they sent all their spoils to the king of Damascus.

24 For the force of Syria came with few men, and God delivered an exceedingly great force into their hands, because they abandoned the Lord God of their fathers; and he executed judgments with Joas.

25 And after they departed from him, leaving him with great diseases, his servants attacked him for the blood of the son of Jodae the priest and put him to death on his bed, and he died; and they buried him in the city of David, and did not bury him in the tomb of the kings.

26 And those who attacked him were Zabed, the son of Samath, the Ammanite, and Jozabed, the son of Somaroth, the Moabite,

27 and all his sons, and the five approached him. And the remaining things, behold, are written in the writing of the kings; and Amasias his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 25

1 Amasias became king when he was twenty-five years old, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Joaden from Jerusalem.

2 And he did the straight before the Lord, but not with a full heart.

3 And it came to pass, when the kingdom was established in his hand, he put to death his servants who murdered the king his father;

4 and he did not kill their sons, according to the covenant of the law of the Lord, as it is written, as the Lord commanded, saying, “Fathers shall not die for children, and sons shall not die for fathers, but each for his own sin they shall die.” –

5 And Amasias gathered the house of Juda and stationed them according to the houses of their families under commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds in all Juda and Jerusalem; and he numbered them from twenty years old and upward and found them three hundred thousand, able to go out to war, holding spear and shield.

6 And he hired from Israel a hundred thousand mighty in strength for a hundred talents of silver.

7 And a man of God came to him, saying, “King, the force of Israel shall not go with you, because the Lord is not with Israel, all the sons of Ephraim;

8 for if you suppose that you will be strong with these, the Lord will also rout you before the enemies, because both being strong and being routed are from the Lord.”

9 And Amasias said to the man of God, “And what shall I do about the hundred talents which I gave to the force of Israel?” And the man of God said, “The Lord is able to give you much more than these.”

10 And Amasias set apart the force which had come to him from Ephraim to depart to their place, and they became exceedingly angry against Juda and returned to their place in furious wrath.

11 And Amasias strengthened himself and took his people and went to the valley of salts and struck there ten thousand of the sons of Seir;

12 and the sons of Juda captured ten thousand alive and brought them to the top of the cliff and threw them down from the top of the cliff, and all were torn apart.

13 And the sons of the force whom Amasias sent back so as not to go with him to war attacked the cities of Juda from Samaria as far as Baethoron and struck three thousand among them and plundered much spoil. –

14 And it came to pass, after Amasias came, having struck Idumea, he brought to them the gods of the sons of Seir and set them up for himself as gods, and bowed down before them, and he himself sacrificed to them.

15 And the wrath of the Lord came upon Amasias, and he sent prophets to him, and they said to him, “Why did you seek the gods of the people, who did not rescue their people from your hand?”

16 And it came to pass, as he spoke to him, he said to him, “Have I made you a counselor of the king? Take care that you are not scourged.” And the prophet fell silent. And he said, “I know that he wished concerning you to destroy you, because you did this and did not listen to my counsel.” –

17 And Amasias took counsel and sent to Joas son of Joachaz son of Ju, king of Israel, saying, “Come, let us be seen face to face.”

18 And Joas king of Israel sent to Amasias king of Juda, saying, “The achouch in Lebanon sent to the cedar in Lebanon, saying, ‘Give your daughter to my son as a wife.’ And behold, the wild beasts of the field in Lebanon will come; and the wild beasts came and trampled the achouch.

19 You said, ‘Behold, you struck Idumea,’ and the heavy heart lifts you up; now sit in your house, and why do you engage in evil, and you and Juda with you fall?”

20 And Amasias did not hear, because it came from the Lord to deliver him into hands, because he sought the gods of the Idumeans.

21 And Joas king of Israel went up, and he and Amasias king of Juda were seen by one another in Baethsamys, which belongs to Juda.

22 And Juda was routed before Israel, and each fled to the dwelling.

23 And Joas king of Israel caught Amasias king of Juda, the son of Joas, in Baethsamys and brought him into Jerusalem and tore down four hundred cubits of the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim as far as the corner gate;

24 and all the gold and the silver and all the vessels found in the house of the Lord and with Abdedom, and the treasures of the king’s house, and the sons of the interminglings, and he returned to Samaria. –

25 And Amasias, the son of Joas, king of Juda, lived fifteen years after the death of Joas, the son of Joachaz, king of Israel.

26 And the remaining words of Amasias, the first and the last, behold, are they not written in the book of the kings of Juda and Israel?

27 And at the time when Amasias departed from the Lord, they attacked him with an attack, and he fled from Jerusalem to Lachis; and they sent after him to Lachis and put him to death there.

28 And they took him up upon the horses and buried him with his fathers in the city of David.

Chapter 26

1 And all the people of the land took Ozias, and he was sixteen years old, and they made him king in the stead of his father Amasias.

2 He built Ailath; he restored it to Juda after the king slept with his fathers.

3 Ozias became king as a son of sixteen years, and he reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Chalia from Jerusalem.

4 And he did the straight before the Lord according to all that Amasias his father did.

5 And he was seeking the Lord in the days of Zacharias, who understood in the fear of the Lord; and in his days he sought the Lord, and the Lord prospered him.

6 And he went out and fought against the foreigners and tore down the walls of Geth and the walls of Jabne and the walls of Azotus, and built cities of Azotus and among the foreigners.

7 And the Lord strengthened him against the foreigners and against the Arabs dwelling upon the rock and against the Minaeans.

8 And the Minaeans gave gifts to Ozias, and his name reached as far as the entrance of Egypt, because he grew strong to a height.

9 And Ozias built towers in Jerusalem and at the corner gate and at the gate of the valley and upon the corners, and strengthened them.

10 And he built towers in the wilderness and hewed out many pits, because he had many cattle in Sephela and in the plain, and vine-growers in the hill country and in Carmel, because he was a lover of agriculture.

11 And Ozias had forces making war and going out to battle by number, and their number was through the hand of Jiel the scribe and Maasaias the judge, through the hand of Ananias the king’s deputy.

12 The whole number of the patriarchs, the mighty men for war, was two thousand six hundred,

13 and with them a warlike force, three hundred thousand and seven thousand five hundred; these were those making war with mighty strength to help the king against the adversaries.

14 And Ozias prepared for them, for all the force, shields and spears and helmets and breastplates and bows and slings for stones.

15 And in Jerusalem he made machines devised by a designer to be upon the towers and upon the corners, to shoot missiles and great stones; and their construction was heard of far away, because he was made marvelous in being helped, until he grew strong.

16 And when he grew strong, his heart was lifted up to destruction, and he did injustice against the Lord his God and entered the temple of the Lord to burn incense upon the altar of incense.

17 And Azarias the priest entered after him, and with him eighty priests of the Lord, mighty sons,

18 and they stood against Ozias the king and said to him, “It is not for you, Ozias, to burn incense to the Lord, but for the priests, the sons of Aaron, who have been sanctified to burn incense; go out of the sanctuary, because you departed from the Lord, and this will not be for you unto glory from the Lord God.”

19 And Ozias became angry, and in his hand was the censer to burn incense in the temple, and when he became angry with the priests, leprosy sprang up in his forehead before the priests in the house of the Lord, above the altar of incense.

20 And the first priest and the priests turned toward him, and behold, he was leprous in the forehead; and they hurried him from there, for he himself also hastened to go out, because the Lord reproved him.

21 And Ozias the king was leprous until the day of his death, and sat leprous in a house of affousoth, because he was cut off from the house of the Lord; and Joatham his son was over his kingdom, judging the people of the land.

22 And the remaining words of Ozias, the first and the last, are written by Jessias the prophet.

23 And Ozias slept with his fathers, and they buried him with his fathers in the field of the burial of the kings, because they said, “He is leprous”; and Joatham his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 27

1 Joatham was a son of twenty-five years when he became king, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Jerousa daughter of Sadok.

2 And he did the straight before the Lord according to all that Ozias his father did, but he did not enter the temple of the Lord, and still the people were being corrupted.

3 He built the high gate of the house of the Lord and built much in the wall of Ophla;

4 and he built cities in the mountain of Juda, and in the forests both dwellings and towers.

5 He fought against the king of the sons of Ammon and prevailed against him; and the sons of Ammon gave him each year a hundred talents of silver and ten thousand kors of wheat and ten thousand of barley; these the king of Ammon brought him each year, in the first year and the second and the third.

6 And Joatham grew strong, because he prepared his ways before the Lord his God.

7 And the remaining words of Joatham and the war and his deeds, behold, are written in the book of the kings of Juda and Israel.

9 And Joatham slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David, and Achaz his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 28

1 Achaz was a son of twenty years when he became king, and he reigned sixteen years in Jerusalem; and he did not do the straight before the Lord as David his father.

2 And he walked according to the ways of the kings of Israel; for he also made carved things for their idols

3 and sacrificed in Gaibenenom and led his children through fire according to the abominations of the nations which the Lord destroyed from before the sons of Israel,

4 and burned incense upon the high places and upon the roofs and underneath every leafy tree.

5 And the Lord his God delivered him through the hand of the king of Syria, and he struck among him and took a great captivity from them and brought to Damascus; for he also delivered him into the hands of the king of Israel, and he struck among him a great blow.

6 And Phakee, the son of Romelias, king of Israel, killed in Juda in one day a hundred and twenty thousand men mighty in strength, because they abandoned the Lord God of their fathers.

7 And Ezekri, the mighty man of Ephraim, killed Maasaias the king’s son and Esdrikam leader of his house and Elkana the king’s deputy.

8 And the sons of Israel took captive from their brothers three hundred thousand, women, sons and daughters, and plundered much spoil from them and brought the spoils to Samaria. –

9 And there was the prophet of the Lord, Oded his name, and he went out to meet the force of those coming to Samaria and said to them, “Behold, the wrath of the Lord God of your fathers is upon Juda, and he delivered them into your hands, and you killed among them in wrath; it has reached the heavens.

10 And now you say that you will acquire the sons of Juda and Jerusalem as male and female slaves; behold, am I not with you to testify to the Lord your God?

11 And now hear me and send back the captivity which you took captive from your brothers, because the furious wrath of the Lord is upon you.”

12 And rulers from the sons of Ephraim, Oudias the son of Joanos and Barachias the son of Mosolamoth and Ezekias the son of Sellem and Amasias the son of Chodli, rose against those coming from the war

13 and said to them, “You shall certainly not bring the captivity here to us, because you say that we should sin against the Lord, to add to our sins and to the ignorance, because our sin is great, and the furious wrath of the Lord is upon Israel.”

14 And the warriors left the captivity and the spoils before the rulers and all the assembly.

15 And men who were called by name rose and took hold of the captivity and clothed all the naked from the spoils, and dressed them and shod them and gave them to eat and to anoint themselves, and helped every weak one upon beasts of burden and brought them to Jericho, the city of palms, to their brothers, and returned to Samaria.

16 At that time Achaz sent to the king of Assour to help him,

17 also in this, because Idumeans attacked and struck in Juda and took a captivity captive,

18 and the foreigners attacked the cities of the plain and on the southwest of Juda, and took Baethsamys and Ailon and Gaderoth and Socho and its villages and Thamna and its villages and Gamzo and its villages, and dwelt there.

19 For the Lord humbled Juda through Achaz king of Juda, because he departed in revolt from the Lord.

20 And Thaglathphellasar king of Assour came against him and struck him.

21 And Achaz took the things in the house of the Lord and the things in the house of the king and of the rulers and gave to the king of Assour, and not for help to him.

22 But in his being afflicted he further departed from the Lord, and the king said,

23 “I will seek the gods of Damascus who strike me”; and he said, “Because they are the gods of the king of Syria, they will strengthen them; therefore I will sacrifice to them, and they will help me.” And they became a stumbling block to him and to all Israel.

24 And Achaz removed the vessels of the house of the Lord and cut them up and closed the doors of the house of the Lord and made himself altars in every corner in Jerusalem;

25 and in every city after city in Juda he made high places to burn incense to foreign gods, and they provoked the Lord, the God of their fathers, to anger.

26 And his remaining words and his deeds, the first and the last, behold, are written in the book of the kings of Juda and Israel.

27 And Achaz slept with his fathers and was buried in the city of David, because they did not bring him into the tombs of the kings of Israel; and Ezekias his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 29

1 And Ezekias became king when he was twenty-five years old, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem, and his mother’s name was Abba daughter of Zacharias.

2 And he did the straight before the Lord according to all that David his father did.

3 And it came to pass, when he stood over his kingdom, in the first month he opened the doors of the house of the Lord and repaired them.

4 And he brought in the priests and the Levites and stationed them on the side toward the east,

5 and said to them, “Hear, Levites; now purify yourselves and purify the house of the Lord God of your fathers and cast the uncleanness out of the holy things;

6 for our fathers departed and did the evil before the Lord and abandoned him and turned their face away from the tent of the Lord and gave the neck,

7 and closed the doors of the temple and extinguished the lamps and did not burn incense and did not bring whole burnt offerings in the holy place to the God of Israel.

8 And the Lord was angry with wrath against Juda and against Jerusalem and gave them up to terror and disappearance and hissing, as you see with your eyes.

9 And behold, your fathers have been struck with a sword, and your sons and your daughters and your wives are in captivity in a land not their own, which is so even now.

10 On account of these things it is now upon the heart to make a covenant of the Lord God of Israel, and he will turn his furious wrath away from us.

11 And now do not leave off, because the Lord has chosen among you to stand before him to minister and to be those ministering to him and burning incense.” –

12 And the Levites rose: Maath the son of Amasi and Joel the son of Azarias from the sons of Kaath, and from the sons of Merari, Kis the son of Abdi and Azarias the son of Jallelel, and from the sons of Gedsoni, Joa the son of Zemmath and Jodan the son of Joacha,

13 and of the sons of Elisaphan, Sambri and Jiel, and of the sons of Asaph, Zacharias and Maththanias,

14 and of the sons of Aiman, Jiel and Semei, and of the sons of Idithon, Samaias and Oziel,

15 and they gathered their brothers and purified themselves according to the king’s command, through an ordinance of the Lord, to cleanse the house of the Lord.

16 And the priests entered within the house of the Lord to purify and cast out all the uncleanness found in the house of the Lord into the court of the house of the Lord, and the Levites received it to cast out into the torrent of Kedron outside.

17 And they began to purify on the first day, the new moon of the first month, and on the eighth day of the month they entered the temple of the Lord and purified the house of the Lord in eight days, and on the sixteenth day of the first month they finished.

18 And they entered within to Ezekias the king and said, “We purified all the things in the house of the Lord, the altar of the whole burnt offering and its vessels, and the table of the setting forth and its vessels;

19 and all the vessels which king Achaz defiled in his reign, in his revolt, we have prepared and purified; behold, they are before the altar of the Lord.” –

20 And Ezekias the king rose early and gathered the rulers of the city and went up to the house of the Lord,

21 and brought up seven calves, seven rams, seven lambs, seven male goats of the goats for sin, for the kingdom and for the holy things and for Israel, and told the sons of Aaron, the priests, to go up upon the altar of the Lord.

22 And they slaughtered the calves, and the priests received the blood and poured it upon the altar; and they slaughtered the rams and poured the blood upon the altar; and they slaughtered the lambs and poured the blood around the altar;

23 and they brought the male goats for sin before the king and the assembly, and laid their hands upon them,

24 and the priests slaughtered them and made atonement with their blood toward the altar, and made atonement for all Israel, because the whole burnt offering and the things for sin were for all Israel, the king said.

25 And he stationed the Levites in the house of the Lord with cymbals and nablas and lyres according to the command of David the king and Gad the seer for the king and Nathan the prophet, because through the command of the Lord was the ordinance in the hand of the prophets;

26 and the Levites stood with David’s instruments and the priests with the trumpets.

27 And Ezekias said to offer the whole burnt offering upon the altar; and when they began to offer the whole burnt offering, they began to sing to the Lord, and the trumpets with the instruments of David king of Israel.

28 And all the assembly bowed down, and the psalm-singers were singing, and the trumpets sounding, until the whole burnt offering was completed.

29 And when they finished offering, the king and all those present bent down and worshiped.

30 And Ezekias the king and the rulers told the Levites to hymn the Lord in the words of David and Asaph the prophet; and they hymned with gladness and fell down and worshiped.

31 And Ezekias answered and said, “Now you filled your hands for the Lord; bring near and bring sacrifices and offerings of praise into the house of the Lord”; and the assembly brought up sacrifices and offerings of praise into the house of the Lord, and everyone eager in heart, whole burnt offerings.

32 And the number of the whole burnt offering which the assembly brought up was seventy calves, a hundred rams, two hundred lambs; all these for a whole burnt offering to the Lord.

33 And the sanctified ones were six hundred calves, three thousand sheep.

34 But the priests were few and could not skin the whole burnt offering, and their brothers the Levites helped them until the work was completed and until the priests were purified, because the Levites purified themselves more eagerly than the priests.

35 And the whole burnt offering was great, with the fats of the completion of the salvation offering and the libations of the whole burnt offering; and the work in the house of the Lord was set right.

36 And Ezekias and all the people rejoiced because God had prepared for the people, because the matter came to pass suddenly.

Chapter 30

1 And Ezekias sent to all Israel and Juda and wrote letters to Ephraim and Manasse to come to the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, to keep the Passover for the Lord God of Israel;

2 and the king and the rulers and all the assembly in Jerusalem took counsel to keep the Passover in the second month;

3 for they could not keep it at that time, because sufficient priests had not purified themselves, and the people had not gathered to Jerusalem.

4 And the matter was pleasing before the king and before the assembly.

5 And they established a word for a proclamation to go through all Israel from Bersabee as far as Dan, to come and keep the Passover for the Lord God of Israel in Jerusalem, because a multitude had not kept it according to the writing.

6 And the runners went with the letters from the king and the rulers to all Israel and Juda according to the king’s ordinance, saying, “Sons of Israel, turn to the God of Abraham and Isaac and Israel, and he will turn back those who escaped, who were left from the hand of the king of Assour;

7 and do not become as your fathers and your brothers, who departed from the Lord God of their fathers, and he delivered them to desolation, as you see.

8 And now do not harden your necks; give glory to the Lord God and enter his sanctuary which he sanctified forever, and serve the Lord your God, and he will turn furious wrath away from you.

9 For when you turn to the Lord, your brothers and your children will be in compassion before all who took them captive, and he will bring back to this land; because the Lord our God is merciful and compassionate and will not turn his face away from us if we turn to him.”

10 And the runners were passing from city to city in the mountain of Ephraim and Manasse and as far as Zaboulon, and they became as those laughing at them and mocking;

11 but men of Aser and from Manasse and from Zaboulon were ashamed and came to Jerusalem.

12 And in Juda the hand of the Lord came to give them one heart to come to act according to the ordinance of the king and the rulers, by a word of the Lord,

13 and many people gathered to Jerusalem to keep the feast of the unleavened things in the second month, an exceedingly great assembly.

14 And they rose and took down the altars in Jerusalem; and all the things upon which they burned incense to the false ones they tore down and cast into the torrent of Kedron.

15 And they slaughtered the Passover on the fourteenth of the second month; and the priests and the Levites were ashamed and purified themselves and brought whole burnt offerings into the house of the Lord.

16 And they stood at their station according to their rule, according to the command of Moses the man of God, and the priests received the blood from the hand of the Levites.

17 For a multitude of the assembly had not purified themselves, and the Levites were to slaughter the Passover for everyone unable to be purified for the Lord.

18 For most of the people from Ephraim and Manasse and Issachar and Zaboulon had not purified themselves, but ate the Passover contrary to the writing. And Ezekias prayed concerning them, saying, “Let the good Lord make atonement for

19 every heart directing itself to seek the Lord, the God of their fathers, and not according to the purification of the holy things.”

20 And the Lord listened to Ezekias and healed the people.

21 And the sons of Israel who were present in Jerusalem kept the feast of the unleavened things seven days with great gladness, and hymning the Lord day by day, and the priests and the Levites with instruments for the Lord.

22 And Ezekias spoke to all the heart of the Levites and of those understanding good understanding for the Lord; and they completed the feast of the unleavened things seven days, sacrificing sacrifices of salvation and giving thanks to the Lord God of their fathers.

23 And the assembly took counsel together to keep another seven days; and they kept seven days with gladness.

24 For Ezekias contributed for Juda, for the assembly, a thousand calves and seven thousand sheep, and the rulers contributed for the people a thousand calves and ten thousand sheep, and the holy things of the priests were in abundance.

25 And all the assembly rejoiced, the priests and the Levites and all the assembly of Juda and those present from Israel and the proselytes who came from the land of Israel and those dwelling in Juda.

26 And there was great gladness in Jerusalem; from the days of Solomon son of David king of Israel there had not been such a feast in Jerusalem.

27 And the priests, the Levites, rose and blessed the people; and their voice was heard, and their prayer came into his holy dwelling, into heaven.

Chapter 31

1 And when all these things were completed, all Israel, those present in the cities of Juda, went out and broke the pillars and cut down the groves and tore down the high places and the altars from all Judea and Benjamin and from Ephraim and from Manasse to the end, and all Israel returned, each to his inheritance and to their cities.

2 And Ezekias arranged the divisions of the priests and the Levites and the divisions of each according to his own service, for the priests and the Levites for the whole burnt offering and for the sacrifice of salvation, and to praise and give thanks and minister in the gates, in the courts of the house of the Lord.

3 And the king’s portion from his possessions was for the whole burnt offerings, the morning and the evening, and whole burnt offerings for sabbaths and for the new moons and for the feasts written in the law of the Lord.

4 And he told the people, those dwelling in Jerusalem, to give the portion of the priests and the Levites, so that they might be strong in the service of the house of the Lord.

5 And when he commanded the word, the sons of Israel increased the firstfruits of grain and wine and oil and honey and every produce of the field, and all the tithes in abundance were brought by

6 the sons of Israel and Juda. And those dwelling in the cities of Juda also brought tithes of calves and sheep and tithes of goats and sanctified them to the Lord their God and brought them in and placed heaps upon heaps;

7 in the third month the heaps began to be founded, and in the seventh month they were completed.

8 And Ezekias and the rulers came and saw the heaps and blessed the Lord and his people Israel.

9 And Ezekias inquired of the priests and the Levites concerning the heaps,

10 and Azarias the priest, the ruler for the house of Sadok, spoke to him and said, “Since the firstfruits began to be brought into the house of the Lord, we ate and drank and left over; because the Lord blessed his people, and we still left over this abundance.”

11 And Ezekias said to prepare chambers for the house of the Lord, and they prepared them.

12 And they brought in there the firstfruits and the tithes in faithfulness, and over them was Chonenias the Levite as overseer, and Semei his brother as deputy,

13 and Jiel and Ozazias and Naeth and Asael and Jerimoth and Jozabath and Eliel and Samachia and Maath and Banaias and his sons were appointed through Chonenias and Semei his brother, as king Ezekias and Azarias the leader of the house of the Lord commanded.

14 And Kore, the son of Jemna, the Levite, the gatekeeper toward the east, was over the gifts, to give the firstfruits to the Lord and the holy things of the holy things

15 through the hand of Odom and Benjamin and Jesus and Semei and Amarias and Sechonias, through the hand of the priests in faithfulness, to give to their brothers according to the divisions, to the great and the small,

16 besides the offspring of the males from three years old and upward, to everyone entering the house of the Lord for the account of days, day by day, for service in the divisions of their arrangement.

17 This was the enrollment of the priests according to the houses of families, and the Levites in their divisions from twenty years old and upward, in arrangement,

18 in enrollments, in all the offspring of their sons and their daughters, for all the multitude, because in faithfulness they purified the holy thing

19 for the sons of Aaron who served as priests, and those from their cities, in every city after city, men who were named by name, to give a portion to every male among the priests and to everyone counted among the Levites.

20 And Ezekias did thus in all Juda and did the good and the straight before the Lord his God.

21 And in every work which he began in labor in the house of the Lord, and in the law and in the ordinances, he sought his God with all his soul and acted and was prospered.

Chapter 32

1 And after these words and this truth, Sennacherim king of the Assyrians came and came against Juda and encamped against the walled cities and said to seize them.

2 And Ezekias saw that Sennacherim had come, and his face was to fight against Jerusalem,

3 and took counsel with his elders and the mighty men to stop up the waters of the springs which were outside the city, and they helped strengthen him.

4 And he gathered many people and stopped up the waters of the springs and the river that divides through the city, saying, “Let not the king of Assour come and find much water and grow strong.”

5 And Ezekias strengthened himself and built all the wall that had been demolished, and towers, and outside another outer wall, and strengthened the supporting wall of the city of David and prepared many arms.

6 And he placed rulers of war over the people, and they gathered to him in the broad place of the gate of the valley, and he spoke to their heart, saying,

7 “Be strong and act as men; do not be terrified before the king of Assour and before all the nation with him, because more are with us than with him;

8 with him are arms of flesh, but with us is the Lord our God, to save and to fight our war.” And the people took courage at the words of Ezekias king of Juda. –

9 And after these things Sennacherim king of the Assyrians sent his servants to Jerusalem, and he was at Lachis and all the army with him, and he sent to Ezekias king of Juda and to all Juda in Jerusalem, saying,

10 “Thus says Sennacherim the king of the Assyrians: In what have you trusted and sit in the siege in Jerusalem?

11 Does not Ezekias deceive you to deliver you to death and to famine and to thirst, saying, ‘The Lord our God will save us from the hand of the king of Assour’?

12 Is this not Ezekias who removed his altars and his high places and spoke to Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem, saying, ‘Before this altar you shall worship, and upon it you shall burn incense.’

13 Will you not know what I and my fathers did to all the peoples of the lands? Were the gods of the nations of all the earth at all able to save their people from my hand?

14 Who among all the gods of these nations which my fathers destroyed? Were they able to save their people from my hand, that your God will be able to save you from my hand?

15 Now let not Ezekias deceive you nor make you trust according to these things, and do not believe him; because the god of any nation and kingdom can certainly not save his people from my hand and from the hand of my fathers, because your God will certainly not save you from my hand.”

16 And his servants spoke further against the Lord God and against Ezekias his servant.

17 And he wrote a book to reproach the Lord God of Israel and spoke concerning him, saying, “As the gods of the nations of the earth did not rescue their peoples from my hand, so the God of Ezekias will certainly not rescue his people from my hand.”

18 And he cried with a great voice in the Judean tongue to the people of Jerusalem upon the wall, to frighten them and pull them down, so that they might seize the city.

19 And he spoke against the God of Jerusalem as also against the gods of the peoples of the earth, works of the hands of men. –

20 And Ezekias the king and Esaias son of Amos the prophet prayed concerning these things and cried to heaven.

21 And the Lord sent an angel and wiped out every mighty warrior and ruler and general in the camp of the king of Assour, and he returned with shame of face to his land. And he came into the house of his god, and some of those who came out of his belly struck him down with a sword.

22 And the Lord saved Ezekias and those dwelling in Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherim king of Assour and from the hand of all, and gave them rest round about.

23 And many brought gifts to the Lord in Jerusalem and presents to Ezekias king of Juda, and he was exalted in the eyes of all the nations after these things.

24 In those days Ezekias became ill unto death; and he prayed to the Lord, and he listened to him and gave him a sign.

25 And Ezekias did not repay according to the recompense which he gave him, but his heart was lifted up; and wrath came upon him and upon Juda and Jerusalem.

26 And Ezekias was humbled from the height of his heart, and those dwelling in Jerusalem, and the wrath of the Lord did not come upon them in the days of Ezekias.

27 And Ezekias had wealth and exceedingly great glory, and he made himself treasures of silver and gold and precious stone and for the spices, and armories, and for desirable vessels,

28 and cities for the produce of grain and oil and wine, and mangers for every beast, and folds for the flocks,

29 and cities which he built for himself, and possessions of sheep and cattle in abundance, because the Lord gave him exceedingly great possessions.

30 Ezekias himself stopped up the upper outlet of the water of Gion and directed them down toward the southwest of the city of David; and Ezekias was prospered in all his works.

31 And thus with the ambassadors of the rulers from Babylon who were sent to him to inquire from him about the wonder which came to pass upon the earth, the Lord also abandoned him to test him, to know the things in his heart.

32 And the remaining things of the words of Ezekias and his mercy, behold, are written in the prophecy of Esaias son of Amos the prophet and in the book of the kings of Juda and Israel.

33 And Ezekias slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the ascent of the tombs of the sons of David, and all Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem gave him glory and honor at his death; and Manasses his son reigned in his stead.

Chapter 33

1 Manasses was twelve years old when he became king, and he reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem.

2 And he did the evil before the Lord according to all the abominations of the nations whom the Lord destroyed from before the sons of Israel.

3 And he returned and built the high places which Ezekias his father tore down, and set up pillars for the Baalim and made groves and worshiped all the army of heaven and served them.

4 And he built altars in the house of the Lord, of which the Lord said, “In Jerusalem my name shall be forever.”

5 And he built altars for all the army of heaven in the two courts of the house of the Lord.

6 And he himself led his children through fire in Gai – banai – ennom, and practiced divination from sounds and from birds and sorcery, and made ventriloquists and enchanters; he multiplied doing the evil before the Lord to provoke him to anger.

7 And he placed the carved thing and the cast thing, an image which he made, in the house of God, of which God said to David and to Solomon his son, “In this house and Jerusalem, which I chose from all the tribes of Israel, I shall put my name forever;

8 and I shall no longer shake the foot of Israel from the land which I gave to their fathers, provided they keep doing all that I commanded them, according to all the law and the ordinances and the judgments by the hand of Moses.”

9 And Manasses led Juda and those dwelling in Jerusalem astray to do the evil beyond all the nations which the Lord removed from before the sons of Israel.

10 And the Lord spoke against Manasses and against his people, and they did not listen.

11 And the Lord brought against them the rulers of the force of the king of Assour, and they caught Manasses in bonds and bound him in fetters and brought him to Babylon.

12 And when he was afflicted, he sought the face of the Lord his God and was exceedingly humbled before the God of his fathers;

13 and he prayed to him, and he listened to him; and he listened to his cry and returned him to Jerusalem over his kingdom; and Manasses knew that the Lord himself is God. –

14 And after these things he built a wall outside the city of David, on the southwest, along Gion in the torrent, and of those going out the gate round about, and into Ophla, and raised it exceedingly. And he appointed rulers of the force in all the walled cities in Juda.

15 And he removed the foreign gods and the carved thing from the house of the Lord and all the altars which he built on the mountain of the house of the Lord and in Jerusalem and outside the city.

16 And he set right the altar of the Lord and sacrificed upon it a sacrifice of salvation and praise, and told Juda to serve the Lord God of Israel;

17 except the people were still upon the high places, except the Lord was their God.

18 And the remaining things of the words of Manasses and his prayer to God and the words of the seers speaking to him in the name of the Lord God of Israel, behold, in the words of

19 his prayer, and how he listened to him, and all his sins and his revolts and the places upon which he built the high places and set up there groves and carved things before turning, behold, are written in the words of the seers.

20 And Manasses slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the garden of his house; and Amon his son reigned in his stead.

21 Amon was twenty-two years old when he became king, and he reigned two years in Jerusalem.

22 And he did the evil before the Lord, as Manasses his father did, and Amon sacrificed to all the idols which Manasses his father made and served them.

23 And he was not humbled before the Lord, as Manasses his father was humbled, because his son Amon multiplied transgression.

24 And his servants attacked him and struck him in his house.

25 And the people of the land struck those who attacked king Amon, and the people of the land made Josias his son king in his stead.

Chapter 34

1 Josias was eight years old when he became king, and he reigned thirty-one years in Jerusalem.

2 And he did what was upright before the Lord and walked in the ways of David his father and did not turn aside to the right and to the left.

3 And in the eighth year of his reign—and he was still a child—he began to seek the Lord, the God of David his father. And in the twelfth year of his reign he began to cleanse Judah and Jerusalem of the high places and the groves and the cast images,

4 and he pulled down before his face the altars of the Baalim and the high places upon them, and he cut down the groves, and he shattered the carved images and the cast images and ground them fine and threw them upon the surface of the tombs of those who sacrificed to them,

5 and he burned bones of priests upon the altars and cleansed Judah and Jerusalem.

6 And in the cities of Ephraim and Manasseh and Symeon and Nephthali and in their places round about,

7 and he pulled down the groves and the altars and chopped the idols fine, and he cut down all the high places from all the land of Israel and returned to Jerusalem.

8 And in the eighteenth year of his reign, to cleanse the land and the house, he sent Saphan son of Eselias and Maasias ruler of the city and Joach son of Joachaz his recorder to strengthen the house of the Lord his God.

9 And they came to Chelkias the high priest and gave the silver brought into the house of God, which the Levites guarding the gate had gathered from the hand of Manasseh and Ephraim and the rulers and from all the remnant in Israel and the sons of Judah and Benjamin and those dwelling in Jerusalem,

10 and those appointed in the house of the Lord gave it into the hand of those doing the works, and they gave it to those doing the works, who were working in the house of the Lord, to repair and strengthen the house;

11 and they gave it to the carpenters and the builders to buy four-sided stones and timber for beams to roof the houses which the kings of Judah had destroyed;

12 and the men were in faithfulness over the works, and over them were overseers, Jeth and Abdias, the Levites from the sons of Merari, and Zacharias and Mosollam from the sons of Kaath, to oversee, and every Levite, everyone skilled in instruments of songs,

13 was also over the burden-bearers and over all those doing the works, work by work; and from the Levites were scribes and judges and gatekeepers.

14 And as they brought out the silver brought into the house of the Lord, Chelkias the priest found a book of the law of the Lord through the hand of Moses.

15 And Chelkias answered and said to Saphan the scribe, I found a book of the law in the house of the Lord; and Chelkias gave the book to Saphan.

16 And Saphan brought the book to the king and further returned a report to the king: All the silver given is in the hand of your servants who are doing the work,

17 and they melted the silver found in the house of the Lord and gave it into the hand of the overseers and into the hand of those doing work.

18 And Saphan the scribe reported to the king, saying, Chelkias the priest gave me a book; and Saphan read it before the king.

19 And it happened, when the king heard the words of the law, that he tore his garments.

20 And the king commanded Chelkias and Achikam son of Saphan and Abdon son of Michaias and Saphan the scribe and Asaias the king's servant, saying,

21 Go, seek the Lord concerning me and concerning all that is left in Israel and Judah, concerning the words of the book that was found; for great is the wrath of the Lord kindled among us, because our fathers did not heed the words of the Lord, to do according to all that is written in this book.

22 And Chelkias and those to whom the king spoke went to Olda the prophetess, wife of Sellem son of Thakouath son of Chelles, herself guarding the robes—and she dwelt in Jerusalem in masana—and they spoke to her according to these things.

23 And she said to them, Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: Say to the man who sent you to me,

24 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am bringing evils upon this place, all the words written in the book read before the king of Judah,

25 because they forsook me and burned incense to foreign gods, to provoke me to anger with all the works of their hands; and my wrath was kindled in this place and will not be quenched.

26 And to the king of Judah who sent you to seek the Lord, thus you shall say to him: Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: The words which you heard,

27 and your heart was moved to reverence and you humbled yourself before my face when you heard my words against this place and against those dwelling in it, and you humbled yourself before me and tore your garments and wept before me, I also heard, says the Lord;

28 behold, I am adding you to your fathers, and you shall be added to your tombs in peace, and your eyes shall not look upon all the evils which I am bringing upon this place and upon those dwelling in it. And they returned a report to the king.—

29 And the king sent and gathered the elders of Judah and Jerusalem.

30 And the king went up to the house of the Lord, and all Judah and those dwelling in Jerusalem and the priests and the Levites and all the people, from great to small; and he read in their ears all the words of the book of the covenant found in the house of the Lord.

31 And the king stood upon the pillar and made a covenant before the Lord, to walk before the Lord, to keep his commandments and his testimonies and his ordinances with all the heart and with all the soul, the words of the covenant written in this book.

32 And he made all those found in Jerusalem and Benjamin stand, and those dwelling in Jerusalem made a covenant in the house of the Lord, the God of their fathers.

33 And Josias removed all the abominations from all the land which belonged to the sons of Israel, and he made all those found in Jerusalem and in Israel serve the Lord their God all his days; he did not turn aside from following the Lord, the God of his fathers.

Chapter 35

1 And Josias kept the Passover to the Lord his God, and they sacrificed the Passover on the fourteenth of the first month.

2 And he stationed the priests at their watches and strengthened them for the works of the house of the Lord.

3 And he told the Levites who were able in all Israel to sanctify themselves to the Lord, and they placed the holy ark in the house which Solomon son of David, the king of Israel, built. And the king said, You have nothing to carry upon shoulders; now therefore minister to the Lord your God and to his people Israel,

4 and prepare yourselves according to the houses of your families and according to your daily divisions, according to the writing of David king of Israel and through the hand of Solomon his son,

5 and stand in the house according to the divisions of the houses of your families for your brothers, the sons of the people, and a portion of a family house for the Levites,

6 and sacrifice the Passover and prepare the holy things for your brothers, to do according to the word of the Lord through the hand of Moses.

7 And Josias contributed for the sons of the people sheep and lambs and kids from the offspring of the goats, all for the Passover for all those found, numbering thirty thousand, and three thousand calves; these were from the king's possessions.

8 And his rulers contributed to the people and to the priests and Levites; Chelkias and Zacharias and Jiel, the rulers of the house of God, gave to the priests, and they gave for the Passover two thousand six hundred sheep and lambs and kids, and three hundred calves.

9 And Chonenias and Banaias and Samaias and Nathanael his brother and Asabias and Jiel and Jozabad, rulers of the Levites, contributed to the Levites for the Passover five thousand sheep and five hundred calves.

10 And the ministry was set in order, and the priests stood at their station and the Levites at their divisions according to the king's commandment.

11 And they sacrificed the Passover, and the priests poured the blood from their hand, and the Levites flayed.

12 And they prepared the whole burnt offering to hand over to them according to the division by family houses, to the sons of the people, to bring to the Lord, as it is written in the book of Moses, and thus for the morning.

13 And they roasted the Passover in fire according to the ordinance, and they boiled the holy things in the bronze vessels and in the cauldrons; and it prospered, and they ran to all the sons of the people.

14 And after preparing for them and for the priests, because the priests were offering up the fat and the whole burnt offerings until night, the Levites also prepared for themselves and for their brothers, the sons of Aaron.

15 And the psalm-singers, the sons of Asaph, were at their station according to the commandments of David and Asaph and Aiman and Idithon, the king's prophets, and the rulers and the gatekeepers of gate after gate; they had no need to move from the ministry of holy things, because their brothers the Levites prepared for them.

16 And all the ministry of the Lord was set in order and prepared on that day, to keep the Passover and bring the whole burnt offerings upon the altar of the Lord according to the commandment of King Josias.

17 And the sons of Israel who were found kept the Passover at that time and the feast of unleavened bread seven days.

18 And there had not been a Passover like it in Israel since the days of Samuel the prophet, and all the kings of Israel had not kept one like the Passover which Josias and the priests and the Levites and all Judah and Israel who were found and those dwelling in Jerusalem kept to the Lord

19 in the eighteenth year of the reign of Josias.

19 a And the ventriloquists and the knowing ones and the tharaphin and the idols and the karasim which were in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, King Josias burned, to establish the words of the law written in the book which Chelkias the priest found in the house of the Lord.

20 There was none like him before him, who turned to the Lord with all his heart and with all his soul and with all his strength according to all the law of Moses, and after him none like him arose;

21 yet the Lord did not turn from the anger of his great wrath, with which the Lord was wrathfully angered in Judah over all the provocations with which Manasses provoked him.

22 And the Lord said, Indeed I shall also remove Judah from before my face, as I removed Israel, and I rejected the city which I chose, Jerusalem, and the house of which I said, My name shall be there.

20 And Pharaoh Nechao king of Egypt went up against the king of the Assyrians at the river Euphrates, and King Josias went to meet him.

21 And he sent messengers to him, saying, What is there between me and you, king of Judah? I have not come against you today to make war, and God said that I should hasten; beware of the God who is with me, lest he destroy you.

22 And Josias did not turn his face away from him, but strengthened himself to fight him, and did not heed the words of Nechao through the mouth of God, and came to fight in the plain of Magedon.

23 And the archers shot at King Josias; and the king said to his servants, Take me out, for I am in great pain.

24 And his servants took him out of the chariot and brought him up onto the second chariot which he had, and brought him to Jerusalem; and he died and was buried with his fathers. And all Judah and Jerusalem mourned over Josias,

25 and Jeremias lamented over Josias, and all the male rulers and the female rulers spoke a lament over Josias until today; and they made it an ordinance for Israel, and behold, it is written among the laments.

26 And the words of Josias and his hope were written in the law of the Lord;

27 and his first and last words, behold, are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

Chapter 36

1 And the people of the land took Joachaz son of Josias and anointed him and appointed him king in place of his father in Jerusalem.

2 Joachaz was a son of twenty-three years when he became king, and he reigned three months in Jerusalem,

2 a and his mother's name was Amital daughter of Jeremias from Lobena.

3 And he did what was evil before the Lord, according to all that his fathers did.

4 And Pharaoh Nechao bound him in Deblatha in the land of Emath, so that he would not reign in Jerusalem,

3 and the king removed him to Egypt, and imposed tribute upon the land, a hundred talents of silver and a talent of gold.

4 And Pharaoh Nechao appointed Eliakim son of Josias king of Judah in place of Josias his father, and changed his name to Joakim; and Pharaoh Nechao took Joachaz his brother and brought him into Egypt, and he died there.

4 a And they gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; then the land began to be taxed, to give the silver at Pharaoh's word, and each according to ability demanded the silver and the gold from the people of the land to give to Pharaoh Nechao.

5 Joakim was twenty-five years old when he became king, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem, and his mother's name was Zechora daughter of Nerias from Rama. And he did what was evil before the Lord, according to all that his fathers did.

5 a In his days Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon came into the land, and he was serving him three years and withdrew from him.

6 And the Lord sent against them the Chaldeans and raiding bands of Syrians and raiding bands of Moabites and sons of Ammon and of Samaria, and they withdrew after this word according to the word of the Lord by the hand of his servants the prophets.

7 Yet the wrath of the Lord was upon Judah, to remove him from before his face because of the sins of Manasseh in all that he did,

8 and in the innocent blood which Joakim poured out, and he filled Jerusalem with innocent blood, and the Lord was unwilling to destroy them.

6 And Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon went up against him and bound him in bronze fetters and led him away to Babylon.

7 And he carried away part of the vessels of the house of the Lord to Babylon and placed them in his temple in Babylon.

8 And the rest of the words of Joakim and all that he did, behold, are these not written in the book of the words of the days for the kings of Judah? And Joakim slept with his fathers and was buried in Ganoza with his fathers, and Jechonias his son reigned in his place.

9 Jechonias was a son of eighteen years when he became king, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem. And he did what was evil before the Lord.

10 And at the return of the year King Nabouchodonosor sent and brought him into Babylon with the desirable vessels of the house of the Lord, and made Sedekias, his father's brother, king over Judah and Jerusalem.

11 Sedekias was twenty-one years old when he became king, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem.

12 And he did what was evil before the Lord his God; he did not show reverence before Jeremias the prophet and from the mouth of the Lord,

13 in rejecting the obligations toward King Nabouchodonosor, which he had made him swear by God; and he hardened his neck and strengthened his heart so as not to turn to the Lord, the God of Israel.

14 And all the eminent men of Judah and the priests and the people of the land multiplied rejection in acts of rejection involving the abominations of nations and defiled the house of the Lord in Jerusalem.

15 And the Lord, the God of their fathers, sent by the hand of prophets, rising early and sending his messengers, because he was sparing his people and his sanctuary;

16 and they were sneering at his messengers and despising his words and mocking his prophets, until the wrath of the Lord rose among his people, until there was no remedy.

17 And he brought against them the king of the Chaldeans, and he killed their young men with the sword in the house of his sanctuary and did not spare Sedekias, and they did not pity their virgins and led their elders away; he handed everything over into their hands.

18 And all the vessels of the house of God, the great and the small, and the treasures and all the treasures of the king and the magnates, everything he brought into Babylon.

19 And he burned the house of the Lord and pulled down the wall of Jerusalem and burned its fortresses with fire and every beautiful vessel to destruction.

20 And he deported the remaining ones to Babylon, and they became slaves to him and to his sons until the kingdom of the Medes,

21 so that the word of the Lord through the mouth of Jeremias would be fulfilled, until the land received its sabbaths to keep sabbath; all the days of its desolation it kept sabbath, to complete seventy years.

22 In the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, after the word of the Lord through the mouth of Jeremias was fulfilled, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians, and he ordered a proclamation throughout all his kingdom in writing, saying,

23 Thus says Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord, the God of heaven, gave me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he commanded me to build him a house in Jerusalem in Judea. Who among you is of all his people? His God shall be with him, and let him go up.

1 Esdras

Chapter 1

1 And Josias held the Passover in Jerusalem to his Lord and sacrificed the Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month,

2 having stationed the priests according to daily divisions, robed in the temple of the Lord.

3 And he told the Levites, the temple servants of Israel, to sanctify themselves to the Lord at the placing of the holy ark of the Lord in the house which King Solomon, the son of David, built: You shall not have to carry it upon shoulders;

4 and now worship the Lord your God and serve his nation Israel, and prepare according to your families and your tribes, according to the writing of David king of Israel and according to the greatness of Solomon his son,

5 and standing in the temple according to your ancestral division, you Levites who are before your brothers, the sons of Israel, in order,

6 sacrifice the Passover and prepare the sacrifices for your brothers, and keep the Passover according to the ordinance of the Lord given to Moses.

7 And Josias gave to the people who were found thirty thousand lambs and kids, three thousand calves; these were given from the royal possessions according to promise to the people and to the priests and Levites.

8 And Chelkias and Zacharias and Hesyelos, the superintendents of the temple, gave to the priests for Passover two thousand six hundred sheep, three hundred calves.

9 And Jechonias and Samaias and Nathanael the brother and Asabias and Ochielos and Joram, commanders of thousands, gave to the Levites for Passover five thousand sheep, seven hundred calves.

10 And these were the things that happened: the priests and the Levites stood in good order,

11 having the unleavened bread according to the tribes

12 and according to the divisions of the fathers, before the people, to offer to the Lord according to the things written in the book of Moses, and thus the morning offering.

13 And they roasted the Passover with fire as is fitting, and boiled the sacrifices in the bronze vessels and cauldrons with a sweet smell and carried them to all those from the people.

14 And after these things they prepared both for themselves and for the priests, their brothers, the sons of Aaron; for the priests offered up the fat until a late hour, and the Levites prepared for themselves and for the priests, their brothers, the sons of Aaron.

15 And the temple singers, the sons of Asaph, were at their station according to the things ordered by David and Asaph and Zacharias and Eddinous, those from the king, and the doorkeepers at each gateway; each cannot leave his own daily service, for their brothers the Levites prepared for them.

16 And the matters of the sacrifice of the Lord were completed on that day, the holding of the Passover and the offering of the sacrifices upon the altar of the Lord, according to the command of King Josias.

17 And the sons of Israel who were found at this time held the Passover and the feast of unleavened bread seven days.

18 And such a Passover had not been held in Israel since the times of Samuel the prophet,

19 and all the kings of Israel had not held such a Passover as Josias and the priests and the Levites and the Judeans and all Israel who were found in their dwelling in Jerusalem held;

20 in the eighteenth year of Josias's reign this Passover was held.—

21 And the works of Josias were set upright before his Lord with a heart full of piety.

22 And the matters concerning him are recorded in the earlier times, concerning those who sinned and acted impiously against the Lord beyond every nation and kingdom, and the things which grieved him perceptibly; and the words of the Lord rose against Israel.

23 And after all this action of Josias it happened that Pharaoh king of Egypt came and stirred up war in Charkamys on the Euphrates, and Josias went out to meet him.

24 And the king of Egypt sent to him, saying, What is there between me and you, king of Judea?

25 I have not been sent against you by the Lord God, for my war is on the Euphrates. And now the Lord is with me, and the Lord is with me, urging haste; withdraw and do not oppose the Lord.

26 And Josias did not turn himself back upon his chariot, but attempts to fight him, paying no attention to the words of Jeremias the prophet from the mouth of the Lord;

27 but he engaged in war against him in the plain of Mageddaous, and the rulers came down to King Josias.

28 And the king said to his servants, Remove me from the battle, for I have become very weak. And immediately his servants removed him from the battle line,

29 and he went up onto his second chariot; and, brought back to Jerusalem, he departed this life and was buried in the ancestral tomb.

30 And in all Judea they mourned Josias, and Jeremias the prophet lamented for Josias, and those presiding, together with women, lamented him until this day, and it was decreed that this should always be done among all the race of Israel.

31 And these things are recorded in the book of the accounts concerning the kings of Judea; and each individual deed of the action of Josias and of his glory and of his understanding in the law of the Lord, both the things done by him earlier and the present things, is recounted in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

32 And those from the nation took Jechonias son of Josias and appointed him king in place of Josias his father, being twenty-three years old.

33 And he reigned in Judah and Jerusalem three months. And the king of Egypt restored him to reign in Jerusalem,

34 and fined the nation a hundred talents of silver and one talent of gold.

35 And the king of Egypt appointed his brother Joakim king, king of Judea and Jerusalem.

36 And Joakim bound the magnates, and seizing Zarios his brother, he brought him up out of Egypt.

37 And Joakim was twenty-five years old when he became king of Judea and Jerusalem, and he did what was evil before the Lord.

38 And Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon went up against him and, binding him in a bronze bond, led him away to Babylon.

39 And Nabouchodonosor took some of the holy vessels of the Lord and carried them away and deposited them in his temple in Babylon.

40 And the things recounted concerning him and his uncleanness and impiety are recorded in the book of the times of the kings.

41 And Joakim his son reigned in his place; for when he was appointed, he was eighteen years old,

42 and he reigns three months and ten days in Jerusalem, and he did what was evil before the Lord.

43 And after a year Nabouchodonosor sent and removed him to Babylon together with the holy vessels of the Lord,

44 and appointed Sedekias king of Judea and Jerusalem, Sedekias being twenty-one years old, and he reigns eleven years.

45 And he did what was evil before the Lord and did not show reverence at the words spoken by Jeremias the prophet from the mouth of the Lord.

46 And having been put under oath by King Nabouchodonosor in the name of the Lord, he broke his oath and withdrew, and, hardening his neck and his heart, transgressed the ordinances of the Lord, the God of Israel.

47 And the leaders of the people and of the priests acted impiously and lawlessly in many things, beyond all the uncleannesses of all the nations, and defiled the temple of the Lord which was sanctified in Jerusalem.

48 And the God of their fathers sent through his messenger to call them back, since he was sparing them and his dwelling.

49 But they sneered at his messengers, and on the day when the Lord spoke, they were mocking his prophets, until he, angered against his nation because of their impious acts, commanded that the kings of the Chaldeans be brought up against them.

50 These killed their young men with the sword all around their holy temple, and did not spare young man and virgin and elder and younger one, but he handed all over into their hands.

51 And they took all the holy vessels of the Lord, the great and the small, and the chests of the Lord and the royal storehouses, and carried them away to Babylon.

52 And they burned the house of the Lord and dismantled the walls of Jerusalem and burned their towers with fire,

53 and finished rendering all its glorious things useless; and he led the remaining ones away with the sword to Babylon.

54 And they were servants to him and to his sons until the Persians became kings, to fulfill the word of the Lord in the mouth of Jeremias:

55 Until the land takes pleasure in its sabbaths, all the time of its desolation, it will keep sabbath to complete seventy years.

Chapter 2

1 In the first year of Cyrus's reign over the Persians, for the completion of the word of the Lord in the mouth of Jeremias, the Lord stirred the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians, and he proclaimed throughout his kingdom and at the same time through writings, saying,

2 Thus says Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord of Israel, the Lord Most High, appointed me king of the inhabited world, and signified to me that I should build him a house in Jerusalem in Judea.

3 If therefore any of you is of his nation, let his Lord be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem in Judea and build the house of the Lord of Israel [this is the Lord who dwelt in Jerusalem].

4 As many therefore as dwell in various places, let those in his place help him with gold and silver, with gifts, with horses and livestock, together with the other things added according to vows for the temple of the Lord in Jerusalem.—

5 And the tribal heads of the families of the tribe of Judah and Benjamin and the priests and the Levites and of all whose spirit the Lord stirred arose to go up to build a house for the Lord in Jerusalem,

6 and those around them helped in all things, with silver and gold, horses and livestock, and very many votive offerings from many whose mind was stirred.

7 And King Cyrus brought out the holy vessels of the Lord which Nabouchodonosor removed from Jerusalem and deposited in his own idol temple;

8 and Cyrus king of the Persians brought them out and handed them to Mithridates his own treasurer, and through him they were handed to Sanabassaros, governor of Judea.

9 And their number was: a thousand gold libation vessels, a thousand silver libation vessels, twenty-nine silver censers,

10 thirty gold bowls, two thousand four hundred ten silver ones, and a thousand other vessels.

11 And all the vessels conveyed, gold and silver, were five thousand four hundred sixty-nine, and they were brought up by Sanabassaros together with those from the captivity, from Babylon to Jerusalem.

12 And in the times of Artaxerxes king of the Persians, Beslemos and Mithradates and Tabellios and Raoumos and Beelteemos and Samsaios the scribe and the rest who were associated with them, dwelling in Samaria and the other places, wrote to him against those dwelling in Judea and Jerusalem the letter written below:

13 To King Artaxerxes, lord, your servants Raoumos, the officer of affairs, and Samsaios the scribe and the remaining judges of their council in Coele Syria and Phoenicia:

14 And now let it be known to the lord king that the Judeans who came up from you to us, coming to Jerusalem, are building the rebellious and evil city, and are repairing its marketplaces and walls and laying foundations for a temple.

15 If therefore this city is built and the walls are completed, they will certainly not endure paying taxation, but will even resist kings.

16 And since the matters concerning the temple are being worked on, we consider it good not to overlook such a thing, but to address the lord king, so that, if it seems good to you, an examination may be made in the books from your fathers;

17 and you will find in the records the things written about these matters and know that that city was rebellious and troubling kings and cities, and the Judeans were rebels and were organizing sieges in it from of old, for which reason this city was also desolated.

18 Now therefore we inform you, lord king, that if this city is built and its walls are raised, you will no longer have access to Coele Syria and Phoenicia.—

19 Then the king wrote back to Raoumos, the recorder of affairs, and Beelteemos and Samsaios the scribe and the rest who were associated with them and dwelling in Samaria and Syria and Phoenicia the things written below:

20 I read the letter which you have sent to me.

21 I therefore ordered an examination, and it was found that that city has been opposing kings from of old, and the men were carrying out revolts and wars in it,

22 and strong and harsh kings were in Jerusalem, ruling and taxing Coele Syria and Phoenicia.

23 Now therefore I ordered those men to be prevented from building the city,

24 and provision to be made that nothing happen contrary to these things and that the matters of wickedness not advance further to trouble kings.—

25 Then, when the writings from King Artaxerxes were read, Raoumos and Samsaios the scribe and those associated with them set out in haste to Jerusalem with cavalry and a battle array of people and began to hinder those building.

26 And the building of the temple in Jerusalem was idle until the second year of the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

Chapter 3

1 And King Darius made a great reception for all those under him and all his household servants and all the magnates of Media and Persia,

2 and all the satraps and generals and local rulers under him, from India to Ethiopia, in the hundred twenty-seven satrapies.

3 And they ate and drank and, filled, departed; and King Darius departed to the bedchamber and slept and became awake.

4 Then the three young men, the bodyguards who guarded the king's body, said to one another,

5 Let each of us speak one word, which will prevail; and whoever's saying appears wiser than the other's, King Darius will give him great gifts and great victory rewards,

6 and purple to put on, and to drink in gold vessels and sleep upon gold, and a chariot with a gold bridle and a fine linen turban and a necklace around the neck,

7 and he will sit second to Darius because of his wisdom and will be called a kinsman of Darius.

8 And then each wrote his own word, and they sealed them and placed them under the pillow of King Darius and said,

9 When the king rises, they will give him the writing, and whoever the king and the three magnates of Persia judge to have the wiser word, to him the victory shall be given, as it is written.

10 The one wrote, Wine prevails.

11 The other wrote, The king prevails.

12 The third wrote, Women prevail, but above all things truth conquers.

13 And when the king rose, they took the writing and gave it to him, and he read it.

14 And he sent and called all the magnates of Persia and Media and satraps and generals and local rulers and high officials, and sat in the council chamber, and the writing was read before them.

15 And he said, Call the young men, and they will explain their words; and they were called and entered.

16 And they said to them, Tell us about the things written.

17 And the first, who had spoken about the strength of wine, began and spoke thus:

18 Men, how does wine prevail? It leads astray the mind of all the people who drink it.

19 It makes the mind of both the king and the orphan one, both that of the servant and that of the free man, both that of the poor man and that of the rich man.

20 And it turns every mind to feasting and gladness, and one remembers no sorrow and no debt.

21 And it makes all hearts rich, and one remembers neither king nor satrap, and it makes one speak of all things in terms of talents.

22 And one does not remember, when they drink, to be friendly with friends and brothers, and after a little while they draw swords;

23 and when they are free of the wine, one does not remember what they did.

24 O men, does wine not prevail, since it compels one to act thus? And he fell silent after speaking thus.

Chapter 4

1 And the second began to speak, the one who had spoken about the strength of the king:

2 O men, do people not prevail, holding dominion over the land and the sea and all things in them?

3 But the king prevails and rules them and is master over them, and everything he may say to them, they obey.

4 If he tells them to make war against one another, they do so; and if he sends them against the enemies, they go and subdue the mountains and the walls and the towers.

5 They kill and are killed and do not transgress the king's word; and if they conquer, they bring everything to the king, both whatever they plunder and all the other things.

6 And as many as do not serve as soldiers or make war, but cultivate the land, again, when they sow, they harvest and bring up to the king; and compelling one another, they bring up the tributes to the king.

7 And he is one alone; if he says to kill, they kill; he said to release, they release;

8 he said to strike, they strike; he said to desolate, they desolate; he said to build, they build;

9 he said to cut down, they cut down; he said to plant, they plant.

10 And all his people and his forces obey.

11 And besides these things he reclines, eats and drinks and sleeps, but they keep watch all around him, and each cannot go away and do his own works, nor do they disobey him.

12 O men, how does the king not prevail, since he is so obeyed? And he fell silent.

13 And the third, who had spoken about women and truth—this is Zorobabel—began to speak:

14 Men, is the king not great, and are people not many, and is wine not strong? Who then is master over them, or who rules them? Is it not women?

15 Women gave birth to the king and all the people who rule the sea and the land;

16 and from them they came to be, and these reared them, those who plant the vineyards from which wine comes.

17 And these make people's robes, and these give glory to people, and people cannot exist without women.

18 And if they gather gold and silver and every beautiful thing, and see one woman lovely in appearance and beauty,

19 then, leaving all these things, they gape at her and, opening their mouth, gaze at her, and all prefer her to gold and silver and every beautiful thing.

20 A man forsakes his own father who reared him, and his own country, and clings to his own wife;

21 and with his wife he gives up his life, and remembers neither father nor mother nor country.

22 And from this you must know that women rule you; do you not toil and labor and give and bring everything to women?

23 And a man takes his sword and goes out to travel and rob and steal and sail upon the sea and rivers;

24 and he faces the lion and walks in darkness, and when he steals and seizes and strips people, he carries it to his beloved.

25 And a man loves his own wife more than his father and mother;

26 and many went mad in their own minds because of women and became slaves because of them,

27 and many perished and stumbled and sinned because of women.

28 And now do you not believe me? Is the king not great in his authority? Do not all the countries fear to touch him?

29 I was watching him and Apame, daughter of the remarkable Bartakos, the king's concubine, sitting at the king's right,

30 and taking the diadem from the king's head and placing it upon herself, and she was slapping the king with her left hand.

31 And besides these things the king, opening his mouth, was gazing at her; and if she smiles at him, he laughs; but if she becomes embittered against him, he flatters her so that she may be reconciled to him.

32 O men, how are women not strong, since they act thus?

33 And then the king and the magnates looked at one another.—

34 And he began to speak about truth: Men, are women not strong? Great is the earth, and high is heaven, and swift in its course is the sun, because it turns in the circuit of heaven and runs back again to its own place in one day.

35 Is he who does these things not great? And truth is great and stronger than all things.

36 All the earth calls upon truth, and heaven blesses her, and all the works shake and tremble, and there is nothing unjust with him.

37 Unjust is wine, unjust is the king, unjust are women, unjust are all the sons of men, and unjust are all their works, all such things; and there is no truth in them, and in their injustice they will perish.

38 But truth remains and is strong for the age and lives and rules for the age of the age.

39 And with her there is no showing partiality or accepting bribes, but she does what is just apart from all things unjust and evil; and all approve of her works, and there is nothing unjust in her judgment.

40 And hers are the strength and the kingdom and the authority and the greatness of all the ages. Blessed is the God of truth.

41 And he ceased speaking; and all the people then cried out, and then they said, Great is truth, and it prevails.

42 Then the king said to him, Ask whatever you wish, more than the things written, and we will give it to you, since you were found wiser; and you shall sit next to me and shall be called my kinsman.

43 Then he said to the king, Remember the vow which you vowed to build Jerusalem on the day when you received your kingdom,

44 and to send out all the vessels taken from Jerusalem, which Cyrus set apart when he vowed to cut down Babylon, and vowed to send there.

45 And you vowed to build the temple which the Idumeans burned when Judea was desolated by the Chaldeans.

46 And now this is what I request of you, lord king, and what I ask you, and this is the greatness from you; I therefore beg that you perform the vow which you vowed with your mouth to perform for the king of heaven.—

47 Then King Darius rose and kissed him and wrote for him the letters to all the stewards and local rulers and generals and satraps, that they should send him forward and all those with him going up to build Jerusalem.

48 And to all the local rulers in Coele Syria and Phoenicia and those in Lebanon he wrote letters to convey cedar timber from Lebanon to Jerusalem, and that they should build the city with him.

49 And he wrote to all the Judeans going up from the kingdom to Judea concerning their freedom, that no powerful man or satrap or local ruler or steward should come against their doors,

50 and that all the country which they would possess should be free of taxation for them, and that the Idumeans should release the villages of the Judeans which they held,

51 and that twenty talents each year should be given for the building of the temple until it was built,

52 and for whole burnt offerings to be offered upon the altar daily, as they have a command to offer seventeen, another ten talents each year,

53 and that all those coming up from Babylonia to establish the city should have freedom, both they and their children and all the priests coming up.

54 And he also wrote concerning the provision and the priestly robe in which they serve in it.

55 And for the Levites he wrote that the provision should be given until the day when the house was completed and Jerusalem built,

56 and for all those guarding the city he wrote that allotments and wages should be given to them.

57 And he sent out all the vessels which Cyrus set apart from Babylon; and all the things which Cyrus said to do, he himself also commanded to do and send to Jerusalem.

58 And when the young man went out, he lifted his face to heaven toward Jerusalem and blessed the king of heaven, saying,

59 From you is victory, and from you is wisdom, and yours is glory, and I am your servant.

60 Blessed are you, who gave me wisdom; and to you I give thanks, master of the fathers.

61 And he took the letters and went out to Babylon and reported to all his brothers.

62 And they blessed the God of their fathers, because he gave them relief and release

63 to go up and build Jerusalem and the temple upon which his name was named, and they feasted with music and joy seven days.

Chapter 5

1 And after these things the leaders of family houses were chosen to go up according to their tribes, and their wives and sons and daughters and their male servants and female servants and their livestock.

2 And Darius sent with them a thousand horsemen until they were brought back to Jerusalem with peace and with music, drums and flutes;

3 and all their brothers were playing, and he made them go up together with those.

4 And these are the names of the men going up according to their families into the tribes according to their division.

5 The priests, sons of Phinees son of Aaron: Jesus son of Josedek son of Saraios, and Joakim son of Zorobabel son of Salathiel, from the house of David, from the lineage of Phares, and of the tribe of Judah,

6 who spoke wise words in the time of Darius king of the Persians, in the second year of his reign, in the month Nisan, the first month.—

7 And these are those from Judea who came up from the captivity of the sojourning, whom Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon deported to Babylon,

8 and they returned to Jerusalem and the rest of Judea, each to his own city, those who came with Zorobabel and Jesus, Neemias, Zaraios, Resaios, Enenios, Mardochaios, Beelsaros, Aspharasos, Borolios, Roimos, Baana, their leaders.

9 The number of those from the nation and their leaders: sons of Phoros, two thousand one hundred seventy-two.

10 Sons of Saphat, four hundred seventy-two. Sons of Aree, seven hundred fifty-six.

11 Sons of Phaathmoab belonging to the sons of Jesus and Joab, two thousand eight hundred twelve.

12 Sons of Olamos, one thousand two hundred fifty-four. Sons of Zatou, nine hundred forty-five. Sons of Chorbe, seven hundred five. Sons of Bani, six hundred forty-eight.

13 Sons of Bebai, six hundred twenty-three. Sons of Asgad, one thousand three hundred twenty-two.

14 Sons of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-seven. Sons of Bagoi, two thousand sixty-six. Sons of Adinos, four hundred fifty-four.

15 Sons of Ater Ezekias, ninety-two. Sons of Kilan and Azetas, sixty-seven. Sons of Azouros, four hundred thirty-two.

16 Sons of Annias, one hundred one. Sons of Arom, sons of Bassai, three hundred twenty-three. Sons of Ariphos, one hundred twelve.

17 Sons of Baiterous, three thousand five. Sons from Baithlomon, one hundred twenty-three.

18 Those from Netebas, fifty-five. Those from Enatos, one hundred fifty-eight. Those from Baitasmon, forty-two.

19 Those from Kariathiarios, twenty-five. Those from Kapira and Berot, seven hundred forty-three.

20 The Chadisai and Ammidioi, four hundred twenty-two. Those from Kiramas and Gabbe, six hundred twenty-one.

21 Those from Makalon, one hundred twenty-two. Those from Baitolio, fifty-two. Sons of Niphis, one hundred fifty-six.

22 Sons of another Kalamo and Onous, seven hundred twenty-five. Sons of Jerecho, three hundred forty-five.

23 Sons of Sanaas, three thousand three hundred thirty.—

24 The priests: sons of Jeddou son of Jesus belonging to the sons of Anasib, nine hundred seventy-two. Sons of Emmeros, one thousand fifty-two.

25 Sons of Phassouros, one thousand two hundred forty-seven. Sons of Charme, one thousand seventeen.—

26 And the Levites: sons of Jesus and Kadmielos and Bannos and Soudios, seventy-four.

27 The temple singers: sons of Asaph, one hundred twenty-eight.

28 The doorkeepers: sons of Saloum, sons of Atar, sons of Tolman, sons of Akoub, sons of Ateta, sons of Sobai, all one hundred thirty-nine.—

29 The temple servants: sons of Esau, sons of Asipha, sons of Tabaoth, sons of Keras, sons of Soua, sons of Phadaios, sons of Labana, sons of Angaba,

30 sons of Akoud, sons of Outa, sons of Ketab, sons of Agaba, sons of Sybai, sons of Anan, sons of Kathoua, sons of Geddour,

31 sons of Jairos, sons of Daisan, sons of Noeba, sons of Chaseba, sons of Gazera, sons of Ozios, sons of Phinoe, sons of Asara, sons of Basthai, sons of Asana, sons of Maani, sons of Naphisi, sons of Akouph, sons of Achiba, sons of Asour, sons of Pharakim, sons of Basaloth,

32 sons of Meedda, sons of Koutha, sons of Charea, sons of Barchous, sons of Serar, sons of Thomoi, sons of Nasi, sons of Atipha.

33 Sons of Solomon's servants: sons of Assaphioth, sons of Pharida, sons of Jeeli, sons of Lozon, sons of Isdael, sons of Saphythi,

34 sons of Agia, sons of Phakareth—sabie, sons of Sarothie, sons of Masias, sons of Gas, sons of Addous, sons of Soubas, sons of Apherra, sons of Barodis, sons of Saphat, sons of Amon.

35 All the temple servants and the sons of Solomon's servants, three hundred seventy-two.—

36 These came up from Thermeleth and Thelersas, their leader Charaath, Adan and Amar,

37 and they could not declare their families and lineages, that they are from Israel: sons of Dalan son of Touban, sons of Nekodan, six hundred fifty-two.

38 And from the priests, those claiming priesthood and not found: sons of Obbia, sons of Akkos, sons of Joddous, who took Augia as wife from the daughters of Pharzellaios and was called by his name;

39 and when their genealogical record was sought in the register and was not found, they were excluded from serving as priests,

40 and Neemias and Attharias told them not to partake of the holy things until a high priest should arise clothed with the manifestation and the truth.—

41 And the total was: Israel from twelve years old, apart from male servants and female servants, forty-two thousand three hundred sixty; their male servants and female servants, seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven; singers and psalm-singers, two hundred forty-five;

42 four hundred thirty-five camels, and seven thousand thirty-six horses, two hundred forty-five mules, five thousand five hundred twenty-five beasts of burden.—

43 And some of the leaders according to the families, when they arrived at the temple of God in Jerusalem, vowed to raise the house upon its site according to their ability,

44 and to give to the sacred treasury for the works a thousand minas of gold and five thousand minas of silver and a hundred priestly robes.—

45 And the priests and the Levites and those from the people were settled in Jerusalem and the country, and the temple singers and the doorkeepers and all Israel in their villages.

46 And when the seventh month came, and each of the sons of Israel was in his own place, they gathered with one accord in the open space of the first gateway toward the east.

47 And Jesus son of Josedek and his brothers the priests and Zorobabel son of Salathiel and his brothers arose and prepared the altar of the God of Israel,

48 to offer whole burnt offerings upon it in accordance with the things prescribed in the book of Moses, the man of God.

49 And some from the other nations of the land gathered to them. And they set the altar upright upon its site, because all the nations upon the land were hostile to them and overpowered them, and they offered sacrifices according to the appointed time and whole burnt offerings to the Lord, the morning and the evening offering,

50 and held the feast of the pitching of tents, as it is commanded in the law, and sacrifices daily, as was fitting,

51 and after these things continual offerings and sacrifices of sabbaths and new moons and all sanctified feasts.

52 And as many as vowed a vow to God began to offer sacrifices to God from the new moon of the seventh month, and the temple of God had not yet been built.

53 And they gave silver to the stonecutters and carpenters, and food and drink and joy to the Sidonians and Tyrians, so that they would bring cedar timber from Lebanon and convey rafts to the harbor of Joppe, according to the ordinance written to them from Cyrus king of the Persians.—

54 And in the second year, having arrived at the temple of God in Jerusalem, in the second month, Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek and their brothers and the priests, the Levites, and all those who arrived from the captivity in Jerusalem began,

55 and laid the foundation of the temple of God on the new moon of the second month of the second year after coming into Judea and Jerusalem.

56 And they stationed the Levites from twenty years old over the works of the Lord, and Jesus and the sons and the brothers and Kadmiel the brother and the sons of Jesus Hemadaboun and the sons of Joda son of Iliadoun, with the sons and brothers, all the Levites, stood with one accord as overseers working for the works in the house of God.

57 And the builders built the temple of the Lord, and the priests stood robed with music and trumpets, and the Levites, sons of Asaph, having the cymbals, singing hymns to the Lord and blessing according to David king of Israel,

58 and they cried out through hymns, giving thanks to the Lord, because his kindness and glory are for the ages toward all Israel.

59 And all the people sounded trumpets and shouted with a great voice, singing hymns to the Lord at the raising of the house of the Lord.

60 And from the priests, the Levites, and those presiding according to their families, the elders who had seen the house before this one came to its building with shouting and great weeping,

61 and many with trumpets and joy with a great voice,

62 so that the people could not hear the trumpets because of the people's weeping, for the crowd was sounding trumpets mightily, so as to be heard from afar.

63 And the enemies of the tribe of Judah and Benjamin heard and came to learn what the sound of the trumpets was.

64 And they learned that those from the captivity were building the temple for the Lord, the God of Israel,

65 and they approached Zorobabel and Jesus and the leaders of the families and say to them, We shall build with you;

66 for like you we heed your Lord and have sacrificed to him since the days of Asbasareth king of the Assyrians, who brought us here.

67 And Zorobabel and Jesus and the leaders of the families of Israel said to them, It is not for you and us to build the house for the Lord our God;

68 for we alone shall build for the Lord of Israel in accordance with what Cyrus king of the Persians commanded us.

69 But the nations of the land, pressing upon those in Judea and besieging them, kept them from building,

70 and making plots and popular agitations and conspiracies, prevented the completion of the building all the time of the life of King Cyrus.

71 And they were kept from the building two years until the reign of Darius.

Chapter 6

1 And in the second year of Darius's reign, the prophets Angaios and Zacharias son of Eddi prophesied to the Judeans in Judea and Jerusalem in the name of the Lord, the God of Israel, over them.

2 Then Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek arose and began to build the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, the prophets of the Lord being with them and helping them.

3 At that very time Sisinnes the governor of Syria and Phoenicia and Sathrabouzanes and their companions came to them and said to them,

4 At whose order to you are you building this house and completing this roof and all the other things? And who are the builders completing these things?

5 And the elders of the Judeans had favor, oversight having come upon the captivity from the Lord,

6 and were not hindered from the building until Darius was informed about them and an answer was given.

7 A copy of the letter which Sisinnes the governor of Syria and Phoenicia and Sathrabouzanes and their companions, the governors in Syria and Phoenicia, wrote to Darius and sent:

8 Greetings to King Darius. Let all things be known to our lord the king, that, arriving in the country of Judea and coming into the city Jerusalem, we found the elders of the Judeans from the captivity in the city Jerusalem building a great new house for the Lord with costly polished stones, timber being placed in the walls,

9 and those works being done diligently, and the work prospering in their hands, and being completed in all splendor and care.

10 Then we inquired of these elders, saying, At whose command to you are you building this house and laying the foundations of these works?

11 We therefore questioned them to make known to you and write to you the men leading, and we asked them for the list of names of those presiding.

12 And they answered us, saying, We are servants of the Lord who created heaven and earth.

13 And the house had been built many years earlier through a great and strong king of Israel, and was completed.

14 And since our fathers provoked to bitterness and sinned against the heavenly Lord of Israel, he handed them over into the hands of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, king of the Chaldeans;

15 and they pulled down the house and burned it and took the people captive to Babylon.

16 And in the first year of Cyrus's reign over the country of Babylonia, King Cyrus wrote that this house should be built;

17 and the holy vessels, the gold and the silver ones, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and deposited in his own temple, King Cyrus again brought out of the temple in Babylon, and they were handed to Zorobabel and Sanabassaros the governor,

18 and he was commanded to carry away all these vessels and deposit them in the temple in Jerusalem, and that this temple of the Lord should be built upon the site.

19 Then that Sanabassaros arrived and laid the foundations of the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, and from then until now, being built, it has not reached completion.

20 Now therefore, if it is judged fitting, O king, let an examination be made in the royal archives of the lord king in Babylon;

21 and if it is found that the building of the house of the Lord in Jerusalem was undertaken with the approval of King Cyrus, and it is judged fitting by our lord the king, let him address us concerning these things.

22 Then King Darius commanded an examination to be made in the royal archives situated in Babylon, and in Ecbatana, the fortress in the country of Media, one scroll was found, in which these things had been recorded:

23 In the first year of Cyrus's reign, King Cyrus commanded the building of the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, where they sacrifice with continual fire,

24 whose height is sixty cubits, width sixty cubits, with three courses of polished stone and one course of new native timber, and that the expense be given from the house of King Cyrus;

25 and that the holy vessels of the house of the Lord, both gold and silver, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and carried away to Babylon, be restored to the house in Jerusalem where they had been laid, so that they may be placed there.

26 And he commanded Sisinnes governor of Syria and Phoenicia and Sathrabouzanes and their companions and the appointed governors in Syria and Phoenicia to take care to keep away from the place, but to allow the servant of the Lord, Zorobabel, governor of Judea, and the elders of the Judeans to build that house of the Lord upon the site.

27 And I also commanded it to be built completely, and attention to be given that they cooperate with those from the captivity of Judea until the house of the Lord is completed;

28 and that from the taxation of Coele Syria and Phoenicia an allowance be diligently given to these men for sacrifices to the Lord, to Zorobabel the governor, for bulls and rams and lambs,

29 and likewise also wheat and salt and wine and oil continually each year, as the priests in Jerusalem may prescribe to be expended daily, without dispute,

30 so that libations may be offered to God Most High for the king and the children, and they may pray concerning their life.

31 And he commanded that as many as transgress any of the things previously said and additionally written, or even annul them, a timber be taken from his own property and he be hanged upon it, and his possessions belong to the king.

32 For these things may the Lord also, whose name has been called there, destroy every king and nation who will stretch out his hand to hinder or harm that house of the Lord in Jerusalem.

33 I, King Darius, have decreed that it be diligently done according to these things.

Chapter 7

1 Then Sisinnes governor of Coele Syria and Phoenicia and Sathrabouzanes and their companions, following the things commanded by King Darius,

2 oversaw the sacred works more diligently, cooperating with the elders of the Judeans and the temple superintendents.

3 And the sacred works prospered as the prophets Angaios and Zacharias prophesied,

4 and they completed these things through the ordinance of the Lord, the God of Israel,

5 and with the approval of Cyrus and Darius and Artaxerxes king of the Persians the holy house was completed by the twenty-third of the month Adar in the sixth year of King Darius.

6 And the sons of Israel and the priests and the Levites and the rest from the captivity who had joined did according to the things in the book of Moses;

7 and they offered for the dedication of the temple of the Lord a hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs,

8 twelve male goats for the sin of all Israel, according to the number from the twelve tribal chiefs of Israel;

9 and the priests and the Levites stood robed according to tribes over the works of the Lord, the God of Israel, according to the book of Moses, and the doorkeepers at each gateway.

10 And the sons of Israel from the captivity held the Passover on the fourteenth of the first month, because the priests and the Levites were purified together,

11 and all the sons of the captivity were not purified, because all the Levites were purified together,

12 and they sacrificed the Passover for all the sons of the captivity and for their brothers the priests and for themselves.

13 And the sons of Israel from the captivity ate, all those separated from the abominations of the nations of the land, seeking the Lord.

14 And they held the feast of unleavened bread seven days, rejoicing before the Lord,

15 because he turned the counsel of the king of the Assyrians toward them, to strengthen their hands for the works of the Lord, the God of Israel.

Chapter 8

1 And later than these things, during the reign of Artaxerxes king of the Persians, Esdras came up, son of Saraios son of Ezerios son of Chelkias son of Salemos,

2 son of Saddoukos son of Achitob son of Amarios son of Ozios son of Bokka son of Abisoue son of Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the first priest;

3 this Esdras came up from Babylon, being a gifted scribe in the law of Moses issued by the God of Israel,

4 and the king gave him glory, since he found favor before him for all his requests.

5 And some of the sons of Israel and the priests and Levites and temple singers and doorkeepers and temple servants went up together to Jerusalem in the seventh year of Artaxerxes's reign, in the fifth month [this is the king's seventh year];

6 for, leaving Babylon on the new moon of the first month, they arrived in Jerusalem on the new moon of the fifth month, according to the prosperous journey given them from the Lord over him.

7 For Esdras possessed much knowledge, so as to omit nothing from the law of the Lord, and to teach all Israel all the ordinances and judgments from the commandments.

8 And the written ordinance from King Artaxerxes arrived for Esdras the priest and reader of the law of the Lord, of which the following is a copy:

9 King Artaxerxes to Esdras the priest and reader of the law of the Lord, greetings.

10 And I, deciding upon humane things, commanded those willing from the nation of the Judeans who choose to go, and from the priests and the Levites, and those in our kingdom, to travel with you to Jerusalem.

11 As many therefore as intend it, let them set out together, as has been decreed by me and the seven friends who are counselors,

12 so that they may examine the matters concerning Judea and Jerusalem in accordance with what he has in the law of the Lord,

13 and carry gifts to the Lord of Israel to Jerusalem, which I and the friends vowed, and all gold and silver which may be found in the country of Babylonia, for the Lord in Jerusalem, together with what has been given by the nation for the temple of their Lord in Jerusalem,

14 both the gold and silver to be gathered for bulls and rams and lambs and the things accompanying them,

15 so as to offer sacrifices upon the altar of their Lord in Jerusalem.

16 And all that you may wish to do with gold and silver with your brothers, carry out according to the will of your God,

17 and the holy vessels of the Lord given to you for the service of the temple of your God in Jerusalem.

18 And the remaining things, whatever may occur to you for the service of the temple of your God, you shall give from the royal treasury;

19 and I, King Artaxerxes, commanded the treasurers of Syria and Phoenicia that whatever Esdras the priest and reader of the law of God Most High may send for, they should diligently give him, up to a hundred talents of silver,

20 and likewise up to a hundred kors of wheat and a hundred measures of wine and salt in abundance;

21 let all things according to the law of God be diligently carried out for God Most High, so that wrath may not come upon the kingdom of the king and the sons.

22 And it is also said to you that no taxation or other imposition should come upon any of the priests and Levites and temple singers and doorkeepers and temple servants and officials of this temple, and that no one should have authority to impose anything upon them.

23 And you, Esdras, according to the wisdom of God, appoint judges and justices to judge throughout Syria and Phoenicia all those who know the law of your God; and those who do not know it you shall teach.

24 And all who transgress the law of your God and the royal law shall be diligently punished, whether with death or punishment or a monetary fine or removal.

25 Blessed alone is the Lord, who put these things into the king's heart, to glorify his house in Jerusalem,

26 and honored me before the king and those giving counsel and all his friends and magnates.

27 And I became courageous according to the assistance of the Lord my God, and gathered men from Israel to go up with me.

28 And these are the leaders according to their families and divisions who went up with me from Babylon in the reign of King Artaxerxes:

29 from the sons of Phinees, Garsomos; from the sons of Jetamaros, Gamelos; from the sons of David, Attous son of Sechenias;

30 from the sons of Phoros, Zacharias, and with him, according to the record, a hundred fifty men;

31 from the sons of Phaathmoab, Eliaonias son of Zaraios, and with him two hundred men;

32 from the sons of Zathoe, Sechenias son of Jezelos, and with him three hundred men; from the sons of Adinos, Ben—Jonathos, and with him two hundred fifty men;

33 from the sons of Elam, Jesias son of Gotholios, and with him seventy men;

34 from the sons of Saphatios, Zaraias son of Michaelos, and with him seventy men;

35 from the sons of Joab, Abadias son of Jezelos, and with him two hundred twelve men;

36 from the sons of Bani, Assalimoth son of Josaphios, and with him a hundred sixty men;

37 from the sons of Babi, Zacharias son of Bebai, and with him twenty-eight men;

38 from the sons of Asgath, Joanes son of Akatan, and with him a hundred ten men;

39 from the sons of Adonikam, the last ones, and these are their names: Eliphalatos, Jeouel and Samaias, and with them seventy men;

40 from the sons of Bago, Outhi son of Istalkouros, and with him seventy men.

41 And I gathered them at the river called Thera, and we camped there three days, and I examined them.

42 And finding none there from the sons of the priests and from the Levites,

43 I sent to Eleazar and Idouelos and Maasman and Elnatan and Samaias and Joribos, Nathan, Ennatan, Zacharias and Mesolamos, the leaders and knowledgeable men,

44 and told them to go to Addaios, the leader in the place of the treasury,

45 commanding them to speak to Addaios and his brothers and the treasurers in the place, to send us those who would serve as priests in the house of our Lord.

46 And according to the mighty hand of our Lord they brought us knowledgeable men from the sons of Mooli son of Levi son of Israel: Asebebias and the sons and the brothers, eighteen;

47 and Asebias and Announos and Osaias, a brother from the sons of Chanounaios, and their sons, twenty men;

48 and from the temple servants whom David and the leaders gave for the work of the Levites, two hundred twenty temple servants; the list of names of all was recorded.

49 And there I vowed a fast for the young men before our Lord,

50 to seek from him a prosperous journey for us and for our children and livestock with us.

51 For I was ashamed to ask the king for infantry and horsemen and an escort for safety against those opposing us;

52 for we said to the king, The strength of our Lord shall be with those seeking him for every restoration.

53 And again we entreated our Lord according to these things and found him gracious.

54 And I set apart twelve men from the tribal chiefs of the priests, and Serebias and Asabias, and with them ten men from their brothers,

55 and weighed out to them the silver and the gold and the holy vessels of the house of our Lord which the king himself and his counselors and magnates and all Israel gave.

56 And having weighed them, I handed to them six hundred fifty talents of silver and silver vessels of a hundred talents and a hundred talents of gold and twenty gold vessels and bronze vessels from good bronze, shining, twelve vessels resembling gold.

57 And I said to them, You also are holy to the Lord, and the vessels are holy, and the silver and gold are a votive offering to the Lord, the Lord of our fathers;

58 keep awake and guard them until you hand them to the tribal chiefs of the priests and the Levites and the leaders of the families of Israel in Jerusalem, in the chambers of the house of our Lord.

59 And the priests and the Levites who received the silver and gold and the vessels in Jerusalem brought them into the temple of the Lord.

60 And setting out from the river Thera on the twelfth of the first month, we entered Jerusalem according to the mighty hand of our Lord upon us; and he delivered us on the way in from every enemy, and we came to Jerusalem.

61 And when the third day there came, the silver and the gold were weighed and handed over in the house of our Lord to Marmothi son of Ourias the priest,

62 —and with him Eleazar son of Phinees, and with them were Josabdos son of Jesus and Moeth son of Sabannos, the Levites—everything by number and weight, and all their weight was written at that very hour.

63 And those who arrived from the captivity offered sacrifices to the Lord, the God of Israel, twelve bulls for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-two lambs, twelve male goats for deliverance; everything a sacrifice to the Lord.

64 And they delivered the king's ordinances to the royal stewards and the governors of Coele Syria and Phoenicia, and they glorified the nation and the temple of the Lord.

65 And when these things were completed, the leaders approached me, saying,

66 The nation of Israel and the rulers and the priests and the Levites did not separate the foreign nations of the land and their uncleannesses, those of the Canaanites and Chettites and Pherezites and Jebusites and Moabites and Egyptians and Idumeans;

67 for both they and their sons dwelt with their daughters, and the holy seed was mingled with the foreign nations of the land, and the leaders and the magnates partook of this lawlessness from the beginning of the matter.

68 And as soon as I heard these things, I tore the garments and the sacred robe and plucked some of the hair of the head and the beard, and sat down pensive and deeply grieved.

69 And all who were ever moved by the word of the Lord of Israel gathered to me as I mourned over the lawlessness, and I sat deeply grieved until the evening sacrifice.

70 And rising from the fast with the garments and the sacred robe torn, bending the knees and stretching out the hands toward the Lord, I was saying,

71 Lord, I am ashamed, I am abashed before your face;

72 for our sins multiplied above our heads, and our acts of ignorance rose as far as heaven

73 from the times of our fathers, and we are in great sin until this day;

74 and because of our sins and those of our fathers we were handed over, with our brothers and our kings and our priests, to the kings of the earth, to sword and captivity and plunder with shame until this day.

75 And now in some small measure mercy came to us from you, Lord, that a root and a name should be left for us in the place of your sanctuary,

76 and to uncover our light in the house of our Lord, to give us sustenance in the time of our slavery;

77 and in our serving as slaves we were not forsaken by our Lord, but he put us in favor before the kings of the Persians,

78 to give us sustenance and glorify the temple of our Lord and raise desolate Zion, to give us a firm support in Judea and Jerusalem.

79 And now what shall we say, Lord, having these things? For we transgressed your ordinances, which you gave by the hand of your servants the prophets, saying,

80 The land into which you enter to inherit is a land defiled with the defilement of the foreigners of the land, and they filled it with their uncleanness;

81 and now do not marry your daughters to their sons, and do not take their daughters for your sons;

82 and you shall not seek peace in your relations with them for all time, so that, being strong, you may eat the good things of the land and leave it as an inheritance to your sons for the age.

83 And all the things happening to us come about because of our evil works and our great sins.

84 For you, Lord, lightened our sins and gave us such a root; again we turned back to transgress your law, to mingle with the uncleanness of the nations of the land.

85 Were you not angered with us to destroy us until no root and seed and name of ours remained?

86 Lord of Israel, you are true; for we were left a root today.

87 Behold, now we are before you in our lawless acts; for we cannot still stand before you because of these things.

88 And when Esdras, praying, was making confession, weeping, prostrate upon the ground before the temple, a very great crowd from Jerusalem gathered to him, men and women and youths; for there was great weeping in the multitude.

89 And Jechonias son of Jeelos, of the sons of Israel, called out and said to Esdras, We sinned against the Lord and married foreign women from the nations of the land; and now there is hope for Israel.

90 In this let there be an oath for us to the Lord, to cast out all our wives from the foreigners with their children, as was judged fitting by you and as many as obey the law of the Lord.

91 Rise and carry it out; for the matter is yours, and we are with you to give strength.

92 And Esdras rose and put the tribal chiefs of the priests and Levites of all Israel under oath to do according to these things; and they swore.

Chapter 9

1 And Esdras rose from the courtyard of the temple and went into the chamber of Joanan son of Eliasibos,

2 and lodging there, he tasted no bread and drank no water, mourning over the great lawless acts of the multitude.

3 And a proclamation was made throughout Judea and Jerusalem that all those from the captivity should gather in Jerusalem;

4 and as many as do not arrive within two or three days, according to the judgment of the presiding elders, their livestock shall be consecrated, and he himself shall be excluded from the multitude of the captivity.

5 And those from the tribe of Judah and Benjamin gathered within three days in Jerusalem [this is the ninth month, on the twentieth of the month],

6 and all the multitude sat together in the open space of the temple, trembling because of the present storm.

7 And Esdras rose and said to them, You acted lawlessly and married foreign women, adding sin to Israel;

8 and now give confession, glory to the Lord, the God of our fathers,

9 and do his will and separate yourselves from the nations of the land and from the foreign women.

10 And all the multitude cried out and said with a great voice, We shall do thus, as you have said;

11 but the multitude is large and the season wintry, and we cannot stand in the open air, and we did not find, and the work for us is not of one day or two; for we sinned extensively in these things.

12 But let the leaders of the multitude stand, and all those from our settlements who have foreign wives, let them arrive, having taken an appointed time;

13 and the elders and judges of each place, until the wrath of the Lord for this matter is removed from us.

14 Jonathas son of Azaelos and Jezias son of Thokanos undertook according to these things, and Mosollamos and Levis and Sabbataios assisted them in judgment.

15 And those from the captivity did according to all these things.

16 And Esdras the priest chose for himself men leading their families, all by name, and they sat together on the new moon of the tenth month to examine the matter.

17 And the matters concerning the men keeping foreign wives were brought to an end by the new moon of the first month.

18 And among the priests, those gathered were found having foreign wives:

19 from the sons of Jesus son of Josedek and the brothers, Maseas and Eleazaros and Joribos and Jodanos;

20 and they pledged their hands to cast out their wives, and rams for atonement for their ignorance.

21 And from the sons of Emmer, Ananias and Zabdaios and Manes and Samaios and Jiel and Azarias.

22 And from the sons of Phaisour, Elionais, Massias, Ismaelos and Nathanaelos and Okidelos and Salthas.—

23 And from the Levites: Jozabdos and Semeis and Kolios [this is Kalitas] and Pathaios and Ooudas and Joanas;

24 from the temple singers, Eliasibos, Bakchouros;

25 from the doorkeepers, Salloumos and Tolbanes.—

26 From Israel: from the sons of Phoros, Jermas and Jezias and Melchias and Miaminos and Eleazaros and Asibias and Bannaias;

27 from the sons of Elam, Matanias and Zacharias, Jezrielos and Obadios and Jeremoth and Elias;

28 and from the sons of Zamoth, Eliadas, Eliasimos, Othonias, Jarimoth and Sabathos and Zerdaias;

29 and from the sons of Bebai, Joannes and Ananias and Zabdos and Emathis;

30 and from the sons of Mani, Olamos, Mamouchos, Jedaios, Jasoubos and Asaelos and Jeremoth;

31 and from the sons of Addi, Naathos and Moossias, Lakkounos and Naidos and Beskaspasmys and Sesthel and Balnouos and Manasseas;

32 and from the sons of Annan, Elionas and Asaias and Melchias and Sabbaias and Simon Chosamaios;

33 and from the sons of Asom, Maltannaios and Mattathias and Sabannaious and Eliphalat and Manasses and Semei;

34 and from the sons of Baani, Jeremias, Momdios, Maeros, Jouel, Mamdai and Pedias and Anos, Karabasion and Eliasibos and Mamnitanaimos, Eliasis, Bannous, Elialis, Someis, Selemias, Nathanias; and from the sons of Ezora, Sessis, Ezril, Azaelos, Samatos, Zambris, Josepos;

35 and from the sons of Nooma, Mazitias, Zabadaias, Edais, Jouel, Banaias.—

36 All these married foreign women; and they sent them away with children.

37 And the priests and the Levites and those from Israel dwelt in Jerusalem and in the country. On the new moon of the seventh month—and the sons of Israel were in their settlements—

38 and all the multitude gathered with one accord in the open space of the temple gateway toward the east,

39 and told Esdras the high priest and reader to bring the law of Moses handed down by the Lord, the God of Israel.

40 And Esdras the high priest brought the law to all the multitude, from man to woman, and to all the priests to hear the law on the new moon of the seventh month;

41 and he was reading in the open space before the temple gateway from dawn until midday before both men and women, and all the multitude gave their mind to the law.

42 And Esdras the priest and reader of the law stood upon the wooden platform prepared,

43 and beside him stood Mattathias, Sammous, Ananias, Azarias, Ourias, Ezekias, Baalsamos on the right,

44 and on the left Phadaios, Misael, Melchias, Lothasoubos, Nabarias, Zacharias.

45 And Esdras took up the book of the law before the multitude—for he presided gloriously before all—

46 and when he unrolled the law, all stood upright. And Esdras blessed the Lord God Most High, God Sabaoth, almighty,

47 and all the multitude cried out, Amen, and raising their hands up, falling upon the earth, they worshipped the Lord.

48 Jesus and Anniouth and Sarabias, Jadinos, Jakoubos, Sabbataios, Autaias, Maiannas and Kalitas, Azarias and Jozabdos, Ananias, Phalias, the Levites, were teaching the law of the Lord and reading the law of the Lord to the multitude, at the same time imparting understanding of the reading.—

49 And Attarates said to Esdras the high priest and reader and to the Levites teaching the multitude, to all,

50 This day is holy to the Lord—and all were weeping as they heard the law—;

51 go therefore, eat rich foods and drink sweet drinks, and send portions to those who have none,

52 for the day is holy to the Lord; and do not be grieved, for the Lord will glorify you.

53 And the Levites were commanding all the people, saying, This day is holy; do not be grieved.

54 And all went away to eat and drink and rejoice and give portions to those who had none and rejoice greatly,

55 because they were also given understanding in the words in which they were taught.—And they gathered together.

2 Esdras

Chapter 1

1 And in the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, so that the word of the Lord from the mouth of Jeremias would be fulfilled, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians, and he ordered a proclamation throughout his kingdom, indeed also in writing, saying,

2 Thus said Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord, the God of heaven, gave me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he charged me to build him a house in Jerusalem in Judea.

3 Who among you is of all his people? And his God shall be with him, and he shall go up to Jerusalem in Judea, and let him build the house of the God of Israel [he is the God in Jerusalem].

4 And everyone remaining from all the places where he himself sojourns, the men of his place shall take him up with silver and gold and equipment and livestock, together with the voluntary offering for the house of God in Jerusalem.—

5 And the rulers of the families of Judah and Benjamin and the priests and the Levites arose, of all whose spirit God stirred to go up to build the house of the Lord in Jerusalem.

6 And all those round about strengthened their hands with vessels of silver, with gold, with equipment and livestock and gifts, apart from the voluntary offerings.

7 And King Cyrus brought out the vessels of the house of the Lord which Nabouchodonosor took from Jerusalem and placed in the house of his god,

8 and Cyrus king of the Persians brought them out into the hand of Mithradates the gasbarenos, and he counted them for Sasabasar ruler of Judah.

9 And this is their number: thirty gold cooling vessels and a thousand silver cooling vessels, twenty-nine assorted items,

10 thirty gold kephphoure and two hundred silver ones, and a thousand other vessels.

11 All the vessels of gold and silver, five thousand four hundred, all going up with Sasabasar from the deportation, from Babylon to Jerusalem.

Chapter 2

1 And these are the sons of the country going up from the captivity of the deportation which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon deported to Babylon, and they returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each man to his city,

2 who came with Zorobabel: Jesus, Neemias, Saraias, Reelias, Mardochaios, Balasan, Masphar, Bagoui, Reoum, Baana. The number of men of the people of Israel:

3 sons of Phoros, two thousand one hundred seventy-two.

4 Sons of Saphatia, three hundred seventy-two.

5 Sons of Era, seven hundred seventy-five.

6 Sons of Phaathmoab belonging to the sons of Jesoue Joab, two thousand eight hundred twelve.

7 Sons of Ailam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four.

8 Sons of Zathoua, nine hundred forty-five.

9 Sons of Zakchou, seven hundred sixty.

10 Sons of Banoui, six hundred forty-two.

11 Sons of Babi, six hundred twenty-three.

12 Sons of Asgad, three thousand two hundred twenty-two.

13 Sons of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-six.

14 Sons of Bagoi, two thousand fifty-six.

15 Sons of Adin, four hundred fifty-four.

16 Sons of Ater belonging to Ezekias, ninety-eight.

17 Sons of Basou, three hundred twenty-three.

18 Sons of Jora, one hundred twelve.

19 Sons of Asem, two hundred twenty-three.

20 Sons of Gaber, ninety-five.

21 Sons of Bethlehem, one hundred twenty-three.

22 Sons of Netopha, fifty-six.

23 Sons of Anathoth, one hundred twenty-eight.

24 Sons of Asmoth, forty-two.

25 Sons of Kariathiarim, Kaphira and Beroth, seven hundred forty-three.

26 Sons of Arama and Gabaa, six hundred twenty-one.

27 Men of Machmas, one hundred twenty-two.

28 Men of Baithel and Aia, four hundred twenty-three.

29 Sons of Nabou, fifty-two.

30 Sons of Magebos, one hundred fifty-six.

31 Sons of Elam—ar, one thousand two hundred fifty-four.

32 Sons of Eram, three hundred twenty.

33 Sons of Lod, Aroth and Ono, seven hundred twenty-five.

34 Sons of Jericho, three hundred forty-five.

35 Sons of Sanaa, three thousand six hundred thirty.—

36 And the priests: sons of Jedoua belonging to the house of Jesus, nine hundred seventy-three.

37 Sons of Emmer, one thousand fifty-two.

38 Sons of Phassour, one thousand two hundred forty-seven.

39 Sons of Erem, one thousand seven.—

40 And the Levites: sons of Jesus and Kadmiel belonging to the sons of Odouia, seventy-four.

41 The singers: sons of Asaph, one hundred twenty-eight.

42 Sons of the gatekeepers: sons of Saloum, sons of Ater, sons of Telmon, sons of Akoub, sons of Atita, sons of Sabaou, all one hundred thirty-nine.—

43 The Nathinaioi: sons of Souia, sons of Asouphe, sons of Tabaoth,

44 sons of Keraos, sons of Soea, sons of Phadon,

45 sons of Labano, sons of Agaba, sons of Akaboth,

46 sons of Agab, sons of Samalai, sons of Anan,

47 sons of Kedel, sons of Gaer, sons of Reea,

48 sons of Rason, sons of Nekoda, sons of Gazem,

49 sons of Ousa, sons of Phase, sons of Basi,

50 sons of Asena, sons of Maonim, sons of Naphison,

51 sons of Bakbouk, sons of Akipha, sons of Arour,

52 sons of Basaloth, sons of Maouda, sons of Aresa,

53 sons of Barkous, sons of Sisara, sons of Thema,

54 sons of Nasoue, sons of Atoupha.

55 Sons of Abdeselma: sons of Sati, sons of Asepherath, sons of Phadoura,

56 sons of Jeela, sons of Darkon, sons of Gedel,

57 sons of Saphatia, sons of Atil, sons of Phacherath—aseboin, sons of Emi.

58 All the Nathinin and sons of Abdeselma, three hundred ninety-two.—

59 And these are those who came up from Thelmeleth, Thelaresa, Charoub, Edan, Emmer, and they were unable to declare their family house and their seed, whether they are from Israel:

60 sons of Dalaia, sons of Boua, sons of Tobia, sons of Nekoda, six hundred fifty-two.

61 And from the sons of the priests: sons of Chabia, sons of Akous, sons of Berzellai, who took a wife from the daughters of Berzellai the Galaadite and was called by their name;

62 these, the methoesim sought their record, and they were not found; and they were ἠγχιστεύθησαν [sense uncertain] from the priesthood,

63 and Athersatha told them not to eat from the holy of holies until a priest should arise with the enlightening things and the perfect things.—

64 And the whole assembly as one, forty-two thousand three hundred sixty,

65 apart from their slaves and their female servants, these seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven; and these male singers and female singers, two hundred;

66 their horses, seven hundred thirty-six, their mules, two hundred forty-five,

67 their camels, four hundred thirty-five, their asses, six thousand seven hundred twenty.—

68 And some of the rulers of families, when they came to the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, made voluntary offerings for the house of God, to establish it upon its prepared site;

69 according to their ability they gave to the treasury of the work pure gold, sixty-one thousand minas, and silver, five thousand minas, and a hundred kothonoi of the priests.—

70 And the priests and the Levites and those from the people and the singers and the gatekeepers and the Nathinim settled in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

Chapter 3

1 And the seventh month arrived—and the sons of Israel were in their cities—and the people gathered as one man in Jerusalem.

2 And Jesus son of Josedek and his brothers the priests and Zorobabel son of Salathiel and his brothers arose and built the altar of the God of Israel, to offer whole burnt offerings upon it according to the things written in the law of Moses, the man of God.

3 And they prepared the altar upon its prepared site, because terror was upon them from the peoples of the lands, and a whole burnt offering to the Lord went up upon it in the morning and toward evening.

4 And they kept the feast of tents according to what was written, and whole burnt offerings day by day, in number according to the ordinance, the requirement of a day on its day,

5 and after this continual whole burnt offerings, and for the new moons and for all the sanctified feasts, and for everyone voluntarily offering a voluntary offering to the Lord.

6 On day one of the seventh month they began to offer whole burnt offerings to the Lord; and the house of the Lord had not been founded.

7 And they gave silver to the stonecutters and carpenters, and food and drink and oil to the Sedanin and the Sorin, to bring cedar timber from Lebanon to the sea of Joppe, according to the concession of Cyrus king of the Persians to them.—

8 And in the second year of their coming to the house of God in Jerusalem, in the second month, Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek and the remaining ones of their brothers, the priests and the Levites, and all those coming from the captivity to Jerusalem began, and they stationed the Levites from twenty years old and upward over those doing the works in the house of the Lord.

9 And Jesus and his sons and his brothers, Kadmiel and his sons, sons of Judah, stood over those doing the works in the house of God, sons of Enadad, their sons and their brothers, the Levites.

10 And they laid foundations to build the house of the Lord, and the priests stood robed with trumpets, and the Levites, sons of Asaph, with cymbals, to praise the Lord according to the hands of David king of Israel,

11 and they answered in praise and thanksgiving to the Lord, because it is good, because his mercy upon Israel is for the age. And all the people sounded a great voice to praise the Lord at the foundation of the house of the Lord.

12 And many from the priests and the Levites and rulers of the families, the elders who saw the first house at its foundation and this house with their eyes, were weeping with a great voice, and a crowd with shouting and gladness raised a song;

13 and the people were not distinguishing the sound of the shout of gladness from the sound of the people's weeping, because the people cried out with a great voice, and the sound was heard even from afar.

Chapter 4

1 And those afflicting Judah and Benjamin heard that the sons of the deportation were building a house for the Lord, the God of Israel,

2 and approached Zorobabel and the rulers of the families and said to them, We shall build with you, because like you we seek your God, and we sacrifice to him since the days of Asaraddon king of Assour, who brought us here.

3 And Zorobabel and Jesus and the remaining rulers of the families of Israel said to them, It is not for us and you to build a house for our God, because we ourselves together shall build for the Lord our God, as Cyrus king of the Persians commanded us.

4 And the people of the land were weakening the hands of the people of Judah, and they were hindering them from building,

5 and hiring those deliberating against them to scatter their counsel all the days of Cyrus king of the Persians and until the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

6 And in the reign of Asoueros, at the beginning of his reign, they wrote a letter against those dwelling in Judah and Jerusalem.

7 And in the days of Arthasastha, Tabeel wrote in peace to Mithradates, together also with his other fellow servants, to Arthasastha king of the Persians; the tax collector wrote a writing in Syrian and translated.

8 Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe wrote one letter against Jerusalem to King Arthasastha.

9 These things Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe and our remaining fellow servants determined, Dinaioi, Apharsathachaioi, Tarphallaioi, Apharsaioi, Archyaioi, Babylonians, Sousanachaioi [who are Elamites],

10 and the remaining ones of the nations whom the great and honored Asennaphar deported and settled in the cities of Somoron, and the remnant beyond the river;

11 this is the arrangement of the letter which they sent to him: To King Arthasastha, your servants, men beyond the river.

12 Let it be known to the king that the Judeans who came up from you to us came to Jerusalem; they are building the rebellious and evil city, and they have repaired its walls and raised its foundations.

13 Now therefore let it be known to the king that if that city is rebuilt and its walls repaired, there will be no tribute for you, nor will they give it; and this harms kings.

14 And it is not permitted for us to see the king's disgrace; because of this we sent and made known to the king,

15 that he may examine the book of the record of your fathers, and you will find and know that that city is a rebellious city and harms kings and countries, and there have been flights of slaves in its midst from times of old; because of these things this city was desolated.

16 We therefore make known to the king that if that city is built and its walls repaired, there is no peace for you.

17 And the king sent peace to Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe and their remaining fellow servants dwelling in Samaria and the remaining ones beyond the river, and says,

18 The tax collector whom you sent to us was called before me.

19 And a decision was issued by me, and we examined and found that that city rises against kings from days of old, and rebellions and flights occur in it,

20 and strong kings arise over Jerusalem and rule all the west of the river, and full tribute and a portion are given to them.

21 And now issue a decision to stop those men, and that city shall no longer be built, so that according to the decision

22 you may be on guard against allowing relaxation in this matter, lest destruction multiply to the harm of kings.

23 Then the tax collector of King Arthasastha read before Raoum and Samsai the scribe and their fellow servants; and they went in haste to Jerusalem and into Judah and stopped them with horses and force.

24 Then the work of the house of God in Jerusalem ceased, and was idle until the second year of the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

Chapter 5

1 And Angaios the prophet and Zacharias son of Addo prophesied a prophecy to the Judeans in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel over them.

2 Then Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek arose and began to build the house of God in Jerusalem, and with them were the prophets of God, helping them.

3 At that very time Thanthanai governor beyond the river and Satharbouzana and their fellow servants came against them and said such things to them: Who issued you a decision to build this house and complete this provision?

4 Then they said these things to them: What are the names of the men building this city?

5 And the eyes of God were upon the captivity of Judah, and they did not stop them until a decision was carried to Darius; and then a message was sent to the tax collector concerning this.

6 A transcript of the letter which Thanthanai governor beyond the river and Satharbouzana and their fellow servants, the Apharsachaioi beyond the river, sent to King Darius;

7 they sent a statement to him, and these things are written in it: To King Darius, all peace.

8 Let it be known to the king that we went into the country of Judea, to the house of the great God, and it is being built with choice stones, and timber is being placed in the walls, and that work is being done skillfully and prospers in their hands.

9 Then we questioned those elders and said thus to them, Who issued you a decision to build this house and complete this provision?

10 And we asked them their names to make known to you, so as to write to you the names of the men who are their rulers.

11 And they answered us with such a statement, saying, We are slaves of the God of heaven and earth, and we are building the house which had been built many years before this, and a great king of Israel built it and completed it

12 for them. But from the time when our fathers provoked the God of heaven to anger, he gave them into the hands of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, the Chaldean, and he demolished this house and deported the people to Babylon.

13 But in the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus issued a decision that this house of God should be built.

14 And the vessels of the house of God, the gold and silver ones, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and carried away to the king's temple, King Cyrus brought out of the king's temple and gave to Sasabasar the treasurer over the treasury,

15 and said to him, Take all the vessels and go, place them in the house in Jerusalem in their own place.

16 Then that Sasabasar came and laid foundations of the house of God in Jerusalem; and from then until now it has been built and has not been completed.

17 And now, if it is good to the king, let an examination be made in the treasury house of the king of Babylon, so that you may know that a decision was issued by King Cyrus to build that house of God in Jerusalem; and when the king knows concerning this, let him send to us.

Chapter 6

1 Then King Darius issued a decision and examined in the libraries where the treasure is laid in Babylon.

2 And in a city, in the fortress of the city of the Medes, one scroll was found, and this was written in it: Memorandum:

3 In the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus issued a decision concerning the house of God in Jerusalem: Let a house be built, and a place where they sacrifice the sacrifices; and he set an elevation, a height of sixty cubits, its width sixty cubits;

4 and three strong stone courses and one wooden course; and the expense shall be given from the king's house;

5 and the vessels of the house of God, the silver and gold ones, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and conveyed to Babylon, let them be given and go to the temple in Jerusalem, to the place where they were placed in the house of God.

6 Now you shall give, governors beyond the river, Satharbouzana and their fellow servants, the Apharsachaioi beyond the river, being far from there,

7 leave the work of the house of God alone; let the leaders of the Judeans and the elders of the Judeans build that house of God upon its site.

8 And a decision was issued by me that you should never do anything with the elders of the Judeans toward building that house of God; and from the king's possessions, the tributes beyond the river, let expenses be diligently given to those men, so that it may not be stopped;

9 and whatever deficiency there may be, both offspring of oxen and rams and lambs for whole burnt offerings to the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, oil, according to the word of the priests in Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day, whatever they ask,

10 so that they may offer sweet smells to the God of heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons.

11 And a decision was issued by me that every man who changes this word, a timber shall be taken down from his house, and he shall be raised upright and fixed upon it, and his house shall be dealt with according to me.

12 And God, whose name dwells there, will overthrow every king and people who stretches out his hand to change or destroy that house of God in Jerusalem. I, Darius, issued a decision; it shall be done diligently.

13 Then Thanthanai governor beyond the river, Satharbouzana and his fellow servants did thus diligently according to what King Darius sent.

14 And the elders of the Judeans were building, and the Levites, through the prophecy of Angaios the prophet and Zacharias son of Addo, and they rebuilt and completed it by the decision of the God of Israel and by the decision of Cyrus and Darius and Arthasastha, kings of the Persians.

15 And they completed this house by the third day of the month Adar, which is the sixth year of the reign of King Darius.

16 And the sons of Israel, the priests and the Levites and the remaining sons of the deportation, held the dedication of the house of God with gladness.

17 And they offered for the dedication of the house of God a hundred calves, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs, twelve male goats for sin for all Israel, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.

18 And they stationed the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their portions for the service of God in Jerusalem, according to the writing of the book of Moses.

19 And the sons of the deportation kept the Passover on the fourteenth of the first month.

20 For the priests and the Levites were cleansed to a man, all clean, and slaughtered the Passover for all the sons of the deportation and for their brothers the priests and for themselves.

21 And the sons of Israel ate the Passover, those from the deportation and everyone separating from the uncleanness of the nations of the land to join them, to seek the Lord, the God of Israel.

22 And they kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with gladness, because the Lord gladdened them and turned the heart of the king of Assour toward them, to strengthen their hands in the works of the house of the God of Israel.

Chapter 7

1 And after these words, in the reign of Arthasastha king of the Persians, Esdras went up, son of Saraios son of Azarios son of Elkia,

2 son of Saloum son of Saddouk son of Achitob,

3 son of Samaria son of Esria son of Mareroth,

4 son of Zaraia son of Saouia son of Bokki,

5 son of Abisoue son of Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the first priest;

6 this Esdras went up from Babylon, and he was a swift scribe in the law of Moses which the Lord, the God of Israel, gave; and the king gave to him, because the hand of the Lord his God was upon him, in all that he himself sought.

7 And some of the sons of Israel and some of the priests and some of the Levites, and the singers and the gatekeepers and the Nathinim, went up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of King Arthasastha.

8 And they came to Jerusalem in the fifth month; this is the king's seventh year;

9 for on the first of the first month he himself laid the foundation of the ascent from Babylon, and on the first of the fifth month they came to Jerusalem, because the hand of his God was good upon him.

10 For Esdras put it in his heart to seek the law and do it and teach ordinances and judgments in Israel.

11 And this is the transcript of the decree which Arthasastha gave to Esdras the priest, the scribe of the book of the words of the Lord's commandments and his ordinances for Israel:

12 Arthasastha king of kings to Esdras, scribe of the law of the God of heaven: The word and the answer are completed.

13 A decision was issued by me that everyone in my kingdom from the people of Israel and priests and Levites who volunteers to go to Jerusalem should go with you;

14 he was sent from before the king and the seven counselors to examine concerning Judea and Jerusalem according to the law of their God in your hand.

15 And for the house of the Lord, silver and gold which the king and the counselors voluntarily offered to the God of Israel dwelling in Jerusalem,

16 and all silver and gold, whatever you may find in all the country of Babylon, together with the voluntary offering of the people and priests voluntarily offering for the house of God in Jerusalem,

17 and everything coming in, readily enter this in this book: calves, rams, lambs and their sacrifices and their libations, and you shall offer them upon the altar of the house of your God in Jerusalem.

18 And if it seems good to you and your brothers to do anything with the remainder of the silver and gold, do as is pleasing to your God.

19 And the vessels given to you for the ministry of the house of God, hand over before God in Jerusalem.

20 And the remainder of the need of the house of your God, whatever it seems to you to give, you shall give from the king's treasury houses.

21 And from me—I, King Arthasastha, issued a decision to all the treasuries beyond the river—that everything which Esdras the priest and scribe of the law of the God of heaven asks of you should be done readily,

22 up to a hundred talents of silver and up to a hundred kors of wheat and up to a hundred baths of wine and up to a hundred baths of oil, and salt for which there is no written limit.

23 Let everything which is in the decision of the God of heaven be done. Take care lest anyone attempt anything against the house of the God of heaven, lest wrath come upon the kingdom of the king and his sons.

24 And it has been made known to you: among all the priests and Levites, singers, gatekeepers, Nathinim and ministers of this house of God, let there be no tribute for you; you shall not have authority to enslave them.

25 And you, Esdras, according to the wisdom of God in your hand, appoint scribes and judges, so that they may judge all the people beyond the river, all those knowing the law of your God, and to the one not knowing you shall make it known.

26 And everyone who does not readily do the law of God and the law of the king, judgment shall be executed upon him, whether to death or discipline or loss of possessions or bonds.

27 Blessed is the Lord, the God of our fathers, who put it thus in the king's heart to glorify the house of the Lord in Jerusalem,

28 and inclined mercy toward me in the eyes of the king and his counselors and all the king's exalted rulers. And I was strengthened, as the good hand of God was upon me, and gathered rulers from Israel to go up with me.

Chapter 8

1 And these are the rulers of their families, the guides going up with me in the reign of Arthasastha king of Babylon:

2 from the sons of Phinees, Gersom; from the sons of Ithamar, Daniel; from the sons of David, Atous;

3 from the sons of Sachania, from the sons of Phoros, Zacharias, and with him the company, a hundred fifty;

4 from the sons of Phaathmoab, Eliana son of Zaraia, and with him two hundred males;

5 from the sons of Zathoe, Sechenias son of Aziel, and with him three hundred males;

6 and from the sons of Adin, Obeth son of Jonathan, and with him fifty males;

7 and from the sons of Elam, Jesia son of Athelia, and with him seventy males;

8 and from the sons of Saphatia, Zabdia son of Michael, and with him eighty males;

9 and from the sons of Joab, Abadia son of Jiel, and with him two hundred eighteen males;

10 and from the sons of Baani, Salimouth son of Josephia, and with him a hundred sixty males;

11 and from the sons of Babi, Zacharia son of Babi, and with him seventy-eight males;

12 and from the sons of Asgad, Joanan son of Akatan, and with him a hundred ten males;

13 and from the sons of Adonikam, the last ones, and these are their names: Aliphalat, Jiel and Samaia, and with them sixty males;

14 and from the sons of Bago, Outhi, and with him seventy males.

15 And I gathered them at the river coming toward Eui, and we camped there three days. And I examined among the people and among the priests, and I found none of the sons of Levi there;

16 and I sent men to Eleazar, Ariel, Samaia and Alonam and Jarib and Elnathan and Nathan and Zacharia and Mesoulam, and discerning men to Joarib and Elnathan,

17 and brought them out before a ruler in the silver of the place and put words in their mouth to speak to their brothers, the Nathinim in the silver of the place, to bring us singers for the house of our God.

18 And there came to us, as the hand of our God was good upon us, a man sachol from the sons of Mooli son of Levi son of Israel; and at first his sons and brothers came, eighteen;

19 and Asebia and Osaia from the sons of Merari, his brothers and their sons, twenty;

20 and from the Nathinim whom David and the rulers gave for the service of the Levites, two hundred twenty Nathinim; all were gathered by names.

21 And I proclaimed a fast there at the river Aoue, to humble ourselves before our God, to seek from him a straight way for us and our children and all our possessions.

22 For I was ashamed to ask the king for a force and horsemen to save us from an enemy on the way, because we said to the king, saying, The hand of our God is upon all those seeking him for good, and his might and his wrath upon all those forsaking him.

23 And we fasted and sought from our God concerning this, and he heeded us.

24 And I set apart twelve from the rulers of the priests, for Saraia, Asabia and with them ten from their brothers,

25 and weighed out to them the silver and gold and the vessels of the first offering of the house of our God, which the king and his counselors and his rulers and all Israel who were found lifted up.

26 And I weighed out into their hands six hundred fifty talents of silver and a hundred silver vessels and a hundred talents of gold,

27 and twenty gold kaphoure for the journey, a thousand chamanim, and various vessels of good shining bronze, desirable among gold.

28 And I said to them, You are holy to the Lord, and the vessels are holy, and the silver and gold are voluntary offerings to the Lord, the God of your fathers;

29 keep awake and guard them until you stand before the rulers of the priests and the Levites and the rulers of the families in Jerusalem, in the tents of the house of the Lord.

30 And the priests and the Levites received the weight of the silver and gold and the vessels, to bring to Jerusalem, to the house of our God.

31 And we set out from the river Aoue on the twelfth of the first month to come to Jerusalem; and the hand of our God was upon us, and he delivered us from the hand of an enemy and foe on the way.

32 And we came to Jerusalem and stayed there three days.

33 And it happened on the fourth day that we weighed out the silver and gold and vessels in the house of our God into the hand of Merimoth son of Ouria the priest—and with him Eleazar son of Phinees, and with them Jozabad son of Jesus and Noadia son of Banaia, the Levites—

34 everything by number and weight, and all the weight was written. At that time,

35 those who came from the captivity, sons of the sojourning, offered whole burnt offerings to the God of Israel, twelve calves for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, twelve male goats for sin, all whole burnt offerings to the Lord.

36 And they gave the king's ordinance to the king's administrators and governors beyond the river, and they glorified the people and the house of God.

Chapter 9

1 And when these things were completed, the rulers approached me, saying, The people Israel and the priests and the Levites were not separated from the peoples of the lands in their abominations, the Chanani, the Ethi, the Pherezi, the Jebousi, the Ammoni, the Moabi, the Moseri and the Amori,

2 for they took from their daughters for themselves and for their sons, and the holy seed was brought among peoples of the lands, and the hand of the rulers was foremost in this faithlessness.

3 And when I heard this word, I tore my garments and was leaping, and I was plucking from the hairs of my head and from my beard, and I sat remaining still.

4 And everyone pursuing the word of the God of Israel gathered to me over the faithlessness of the exiled community, and I was sitting, remaining still until the evening sacrifice.

5 And at the evening sacrifice I arose from my humiliation; and as I tore my garments, I was leaping, and I bend upon my knees and spread out my hands toward the Lord God

6 and said, Lord, I was ashamed and abashed to lift my face toward you, for our lawless deeds multiplied above our head, and our offenses grew great as far as heaven.

7 From the days of our fathers we are in great offense until this day; and in our lawless deeds we were handed over, we and our kings and our sons, into the hand of kings of the nations, with sword and with captivity and with plunder and with shame of our face, as this day.

8 And now the Lord our God dealt leniently with us, to leave something for us for salvation and to give us a support in the place of his sanctuary, to enlighten our eyes and give a little quickening in our slavery.

9 For we are slaves, and in our slavery the Lord our God did not abandon us, and he inclined mercy upon us before kings of Persians, to give us quickening, for them to raise the house of our God and restore her desolate places, and to give us a fence in Judah and in Jerusalem.

10 What should we say, our God, after this? For we abandoned your commandments,

11 which you gave us by the hand of your slaves the prophets, saying, The land into which you enter to inherit it is a land being displaced by the displacement of peoples of the nations in their abominations, with which they filled it from mouth to mouth in their uncleannesses;

12 and now do not give your daughters to their sons, and do not take from their daughters for your sons, and you shall not seek out their peace and their good forever, so that you may grow strong and eat the good things of the land and bequeath them to your sons forever.

13 And after everything coming upon us in our evil deeds and in our great offense; for there is none like our God, for you lightened our lawless deeds and gave us salvation;

14 for we turned back to scatter your commandments and to intermarry with the peoples of the lands; do not be provoked against us to the point of consummation, so that there is no remnant and survivor.

15 Lord, God of Israel, you are righteous, for we were left surviving, as this day; behold, we are before you in our offenses, for it is not possible to stand before you on account of this.

Chapter 10

1 And as Esdras prayed and as he confessed, weeping and praying before the house of God, a very great assembly gathered to him from Israel, men and women and young men, for the people wept and raised their voice, weeping.

2 And Sechenias son of Jiiel, from the sons of Elam, answered and said to Esdras, We acted faithlessly toward our God and settled foreign wives from the peoples of the land; and now there is endurance for Israel in this.

3 And now let us make a covenant with our God to cast out all the wives and what was born from them, as you wish; arise and frighten them with the commandments of our God, and let it happen according to the law.

4 Arise, for the matter is upon you, and we are with you; be strong and act.

5 And Esdras arose and made the rulers, the priests and Levites and all Israel swear to act according to this word, and they swore.

6 And Esdras arose from before the house of God and went into the treasury of Joanan son of Elisoub, and he went there; he did not eat bread and did not drink water, for he was mourning over the faithlessness of the exiled community.

7 And they carried a proclamation through Judah and through Jerusalem to all the sons of the exiled community, to be gathered into Jerusalem,

8 and everyone who does not come within three days, according to the counsel of the rulers and the elders, all his property shall be devoted to destruction, and he shall be separated from the assembly of the exiled community.

9 And all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered into Jerusalem within the three days; this was the ninth month. On the twentieth of the month all the people sat in the square of the house of God, because of their disturbance concerning the matter and because of the storm.

10 And Esdras the priest arose and said to them, You acted faithlessly and settled foreign wives, to add to Israel's offense;

11 and now give praise to the Lord, the God of your fathers, and do what is pleasing before him, and separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from the foreign wives.

12 And the whole assembly answered and said, Great is this word of yours for us to do;

13 but the people are many, and the season is wintry, and there is no ability to stand outside; and the work is not for one day and not for two, for we multiplied wrongdoing in this matter.

14 Let our rulers, then, stand for the whole assembly, and let all those in our cities, whoever settled foreign wives, come at times by arrangements, and with them elders of each city and judges, to turn away the wrath of the anger of our God from us concerning this matter.

15 Only Jonathan son of Asael and Jazia son of Thekoue were with me concerning this, and Mesoulam and Sabbathai the Levite were helping them.

16 And the sons of the exiled community did so. And Esdras the priest and men who were rulers of ancestral families were set apart by house, and all by names, for they turned on the first day of the tenth month to investigate the matter.

17 And they finished with all the men who settled foreign wives by the first day of the first month.

18 And among the sons of the priests were found those who settled foreign wives: from the sons of Jesus son of Josedek and his brothers, Maasea and Eliezer and Jarib and Gadalia,

19 and they gave their hand to put out their wives, and a ram from the sheep as an offering for offense, concerning their offense;

20 and from the sons of Emmer, Anani and Zabdia;

21 and from the sons of Eram, Masaia and Elia and Samaia and Jiiel and Ozia;

22 and from the sons of Phasour, Elioenai, Maasaia and Ishmael and Nathanael and Jozabad and Elasa. –

23 And from the Levites: Jozabad and Samou and Kolia [he is Kolitas] and Phathaia and Jodom and Eliezer;

24 and from those singing, Elisaph; and from the gatekeepers, Sellem and Telem and Odoue. –

25 And from Israel: from the sons of Phoros, Ramia and Jazia and Melchia and Meamin and Eleazar and Asabia and Banaia;

26 and from the sons of Elam, Mathania and Zacharia and Jaiel and Abdia and Jarimoth and Elia;

27 and from the sons of Zathoua, Elioenai, Elisoub, Mathania and Jarmoth and Zabad and Oziza;

28 and from the sons of Babi, Joanan, Anania and Zabou, Othali;

29 and from the sons of Banoui, Mesoulam, Malouch, Adaias, Jasoub and Salouia and Remoth;

30 and from the sons of Phaathmoab, Edene, Chalel, Banaia, Masea, Mathania, Beselel and Banoui and Manasse;

31 and from the sons of Eram, Eliezer, Jessia, Melchia, Samaia, Semeon,

32 Benjamin, Malouch, Samaria;

33 and from the sons of Esam, Mathani, Mathatha, Zabed, Eliphaleth, Jerami, Manasse, Semei;

34 from the sons of Bani, Moodi, Amram, Ouel,

35 Banaia, Badaia, Chelia,

36 Oujechoa, Jeremoth, Eliasib,

37 Mathania, Mathanai, and they acted,

38 the sons of Banoui and the sons of Semei

39 and Selemia and Nathan and Adaia,

40 Machnadabou, Sesi, Sarou,

41 Ezerel and Selemia and Samaria

42 and Saloum, Amaria, Joseph;

43 from the sons of Nabou, Jiiel, Mathathia, Sedem, Zambina, Jadai and Joel and Banaia. –

44 All these took foreign wives and begot sons from them.

Chapter 11

1 Words of Neemias son of Achalia. And it happened in the month Chaseelou, in the twentieth year, and I was in Sousan abira,

2 and Anani, one of my brothers, came, he and men of Judah, and I asked them concerning those saved, who were left from the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.

3 And they said to me, Those remaining, who were left from the captivity there in the country, are in great evil and in reproach, and the walls of Jerusalem are torn down, and her gates were burned with fire.

4 And it happened, when I heard these words, I sat and wept and mourned for days, and I was fasting and praying before the God of heaven

5 and said, Not so, Lord, God of heaven, the strong, the great and the fearsome, keeping the covenant and mercy for those loving him and those keeping his commandments;

6 let your ear, then, be attentive and your eyes opened to hear your slave's prayer, which I pray before you today, day and night, concerning the sons of Israel, your slaves, and I confess concerning the sins of the sons of Israel which we sinned against you. Both I and my father's house sinned;

7 with dissolution we acted dissolutely toward you, and we did not keep the commandments and the ordinances and the judgments which you commanded Moses your servant.

8 Remember, then, the word which you commanded Moses your servant, saying, If you act faithlessly, I will scatter you among the peoples;

9 and if you turn toward me and keep my commandments and do them, if your dispersion is from the end of heaven, from there I will gather them and bring them into the place which I chose for my name to dwell there.

10 And they are your servants and your people, whom you redeemed with your great power and with your mighty hand.

11 Not so, Lord, but let your ear be attentive to the prayer of your slave and to the prayer of your servants who wish to fear your name, and give success, then, to your servant today and give him into compassion before this man. – And I was cupbearer to the king.

Chapter 12

1 And it happened in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year for King Arthasastha, and the wine was before me, and I took the wine and gave it to the king, and there was no other before him;

2 and the king said to me, Why is your face evil, and are you not being moderate? This is nothing except evil of heart. And I feared very greatly.

3 And I said to the king, Let the king live forever; why should my face certainly not become evil, since the city, the house of my fathers' tombs, was made desolate, and her gates were consumed with fire?

4 And the king said to me, Concerning what do you seek this? And I prayed to the God of heaven

5 and said to the king, If it is good to the king, and if your servant will be favored before you, so as to send him to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, then I will rebuild it.

6 And the king and the concubine sitting beside him said to me, Until when will your journey be, and when will you return? And it was pleasing before the king, and he sent me away, and I gave him a limit.

7 And I said to the king, If it is good to the king, let him give me letters to the governors beyond the river, so as to convey me through until I come to Judah,

8 and a letter to Asaph, keeper of the garden which belongs to the king, so as to give me timber to roof the gates, and for the wall of the city, and for a house which I will enter into it. And the king gave to me according to the good hand of God.

9 And I came to the governors beyond the river and gave them the king's letters, and the king sent commanders of the force and horsemen with me. –

10 And Sanaballat the Aroni and Tobia the slave, the Ammoni, heard, and it became evil to them that a man had come to seek good for the sons of Israel.

11 And I came into Jerusalem and was there three days.

12 And I arose at night, I and a few men with me; and I did not report to a man what God puts into my heart to do with Israel, and there is no beast with me except the beast upon which I ride.

13 And I went out by the gate of the golela and toward the mouth of the spring of the figs and to the gate of the dung, and I was breaking in the wall of Jerusalem which they themselves pull down, and her gates were consumed by fire.

14 And I passed to the gate of Ain and into the king's pool, and there was no place for the beast beneath me to pass through.

15 And I was going up on the wall of the torrent at night, and I was breaking in the wall. And I was at the gate of the ravine and returned.

16 And those guarding did not know what I went for and what I do, and to the Jews and to the priests and to those honored and to the generals and to the remaining ones doing the works, until then I did not report it.

17 And I said to them, You see the evil in which we are in it, how Jerusalem is desolate and her gates were given to fire; come, and let us rebuild the wall of Jerusalem, and we will no longer be a reproach.

18 And I reported to them the hand of God, which is good upon me, and the king's words which he said to me, and I said, Let us arise and build. And their hands were strengthened for good. –

19 And Sanaballat the Aroni and Tobia the slave, the Ammoni, and Gesam the Arabi heard and laughed at us and came against us and said, What is this matter which you do? Are you rebelling against the king?

20 And I returned a word to them and said to them, The God of heaven, he himself will give us success, and we are his clean slaves, and we will build; and for you there is no portion and righteousness and memorial in Jerusalem.

Chapter 13

1 And Elisoub the great priest and his brothers the priests arose and built the sheep gate; they themselves sanctified it and set up its doors, and as far as the tower of the hundred they sanctified, as far as the tower of Ananeel,

2 and at the hands of sons of men of Jericho, and at the hands of sons of Zakchour son of Amari.

3 And the sons of Asana built the fish gate; they themselves roofed it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

4 And at their hand, from Ramoth, a son of Ouria son of Akos held firm. And at their hand Mosollam son of Barachiou son of Masezebel held firm. And at their hand Sadok son of Baana held firm.

5 And at their hand the Thekoin held firm, and adoriem did not bring their neck into their service.

6 And Joida son of Phasek and Mesoulam son of Basodia made firm the gate of Isana; they themselves roofed it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

8 And at their hand Ananias son of Rokeim made firm, and they left Jerusalem as far as the broad wall.

9 And at their hand Raphaia, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made firm.

10 And at their hand Jedaia son of Eromaph made firm, also opposite his house. And at his hand Atous son of Asbania made firm.

11 And second, Melchias son of Eram and Asoub son of Phaathmoab made firm, also as far as the tower of the thannourim.

12 And at his hand Saloum son of Alloes, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made firm, he and his daughters.

13 Anoun and those dwelling in Zano made firm the gate of the ravine; they themselves built it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars, and a thousand cubits in the wall as far as the gate of the dung.

14 And Melchia son of Rechab, ruler of the district of Bethacharm, made firm the gate of the dung, he and his sons, and they covered it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

15 And the wall of the pool of the fleeces, at the king's shearing, and as far as the stairs descending from the city of David.

16 Behind him Neemias son of Azabouch, ruler of half the district of Bethsour, made firm as far as the garden of David's tomb and as far as the pool that had been made and as far as Bethanggabarim.

17 Behind him the Levites made firm, Raoum son of Bani. At his hand Asabia, ruler of half the district of Keila, made firm for his district.

18 After him their brothers made firm, Beni son of Enadad, ruler of half the district of Keila.

19 And at his hand Azour son of Jesus, ruler of Masphe, made firm a second measure of the tower of the ascent adjoining the corner.

20 After him Barouch son of Zabou made firm a second measure, from the corner as far as the door of Bethelisoub the great priest.

21 After him Meramoth son of Ouria son of Akos made firm a second measure, from the door of Bethelisoub as far as the end of Bethelisoub.

22 And after him the priests, men of Achechar, made firm.

23 And after him Benjamin and Asoub made firm opposite their house. After him Azaria son of Maasea son of Anania made firm beside his house.

24 After him Bani son of Enadad made firm a second measure, from Bethazaria as far as the corner and as far as the bend,

25 Phalal son of Euzai opposite the corner, and the tower projecting from the king's house, the upper one belonging to the court of the guard. And after him Phadaia son of Phoros.

26 And the nathinim were dwelling in Ophal as far as the garden of the water gate eastward, and the projecting tower.

27 After him the Thekoin made firm a second measure opposite the great projecting tower and as far as the wall of Ophla.

28 Above the gate of the horses the priests made firm, each man opposite his house.

29 After him Saddouk son of Emmer made firm opposite his house. And after him Samaia son of Sechenia, keeper of the gate of the east, made firm.

30 After him Anania son of Selemia and Anoum son of Seleph, the sixth, made firm a second measure. After him Mesoulam son of Barchia made firm opposite his treasury.

31 After him Melchia son of Saraphi made firm as far as Bethanathinim, and the dealers in small wares opposite the gate of Maphekad and as far as the ascent of the bend.

32 And between the ascent of the sheep gate the smiths and the dealers in small wares made firm.

33 And it happened, when Sanaballat heard that we are building the wall, it was evil to him, and he was greatly angered and laughed at the Jews.

34 And he said before his brothers, Is this the power of Somoron, that these Jews build their own city?

35 And Tobias the Ammanite came beside him, and they said to one another, Surely they will not sacrifice or eat at their place? Will not a fox go up and pull down their wall of stones? –

36 Hear, our God, for we became an object of mockery, and turn their reproach upon their head, and give them over to mockery in a land of captivity,

37 and do not cover over lawlessness.

Chapter 14

1 And it happened, when Sanaballat and Tobia and the Arabs and the Ammanites heard that growth had risen on the walls of Jerusalem, that the breaches began to be blocked up, it appeared very evil to them;

2 and they all gathered together to come to array themselves for battle in Jerusalem.

3 And we prayed to our God and stationed advance guards against them day and night because of them.

4 And Judah said, The strength of the enemies was broken, and the loose earth is much, and we will not be able to build in the wall.

5 And those afflicting us said, They will not know and will not see until we come into their midst and murder them and stop the work.

6 And it happened, when the Jews dwelling beside them came and said to us, They are coming up against us from all the places,

7 then I stationed men in the lowest parts of the place behind the wall in the sheltered places, and I stationed the people by communities with their swords, their spears and their bows.

8 And I saw and arose and said to those honored and to the generals and to the remaining people, Do not fear before them; remember our great and fearsome God, and array yourselves for battle for your brothers, your sons and your daughters, your wives and your houses.

9 And it happened, when our enemies heard that it was known to us, and God scattered their counsel, we all returned to the wall, each man to his work.

10 And it happened, from that day half of those shaken out were doing the work, and half of them were holding out, and spears and shields and the bows and the breastplates and the rulers were behind the whole house of Judah,

11 of those building in the wall. And those lifting with the carrying apparatus were with weapons; with one hand he was doing the work itself, and one was holding the missile.

12 And the builders, each man girded with his sword upon his loin, were building, and the one sounding the horn was beside him.

13 And I said to those honored and to the rulers and to the remaining people, The work is broad and great, and we are scattered upon the wall, each man far from his brother;

14 in whatever place you hear the sound of the horn, there you shall gather to us, and our God will fight for us.

15 And we were doing the work, and half of them were holding the spears, from the rising of dawn until the coming out of the stars.

16 And at that time I said to the people, Lodge in the midst of Jerusalem, and let the night be for you an advance guard and the day work.

17 And I was there, and the men of the advance guard were behind me, and there was not a man among us taking off his garments.

Chapter 15

1 And there was a great cry of the people and their wives against their brothers the Jews.

2 And there were some saying, With our sons and with our daughters we are many; and we will take grain and eat and live.

3 And there are some saying, Our fields and our vineyards and our houses, we pledge; and we will take grain and eat.

4 And there are some saying, We borrowed silver for the king's taxes, our fields and our vineyards and our houses;

5 and now our flesh is like the flesh of our brothers, our sons like their sons; and behold, we subject our sons and our daughters to oppression as slaves, and some of our daughters are being oppressed, and there is no power in our hands, and our fields and our vineyards belong to those honored. –

6 And I was greatly grieved when I heard their cry and these words.

7 And my heart took counsel within me, and I contended with those honored and the rulers and said to them, By exaction you exact, each man from his brother. And I set a great assembly against them

8 and said to them, We have acquired our brothers the Jews who are sold to the nations, of our own free will; and do you sell your brothers? And they were silent and did not find a word.

9 And I said, The matter which you do is not good; not so, in the fear of our God you shall go away from the reproach of the nations, our enemies.

10 And my brothers and my acquaintances and I placed silver and grain among them; let us abandon this exaction, then.

11 Return to them, then, as of today, their fields, their vineyards, their olive trees and their houses; and from the silver bring out to them the grain and the wine and the oil.

12 And they said, We will give back and will not seek anything from them; thus we will do, as you say. And I called the priests and made them swear to act according to this word.

13 And I shook out my mantle and said, Thus may God shake out every man who will not establish this word, from his house and from his labor, and thus he shall be shaken out and empty. And the whole assembly said, Amen, and they praised the Lord; and the people did this thing.

14 From the day on which he commanded me to be their ruler in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year and until the thirty-second year for Arthasastha, twelve years, I and my brothers did not eat their forced levy;

15 and the former forced levies, which before me they imposed heavily upon them, and they took from them in bread and in wine, in addition silver, forty didrachms, and those of theirs shaken out exercise authority over the people, and I did not act so because of fear of God.

16 And in the work of the wall of these I did not take hold; I did not acquire a field; and all those gathered were there for the work.

17 And the Jews, a hundred and fifty men, and those coming to us from the nations around us were at my table.

18 And what was prepared for one day was one calf and six choice sheep, and a young goat was prepared for me, and at intervals of ten days, among all things, wine in abundance; and with these things I did not seek bread of the forced levy, for the service was heavy upon this people. –

19 Remember for me, God, for good, all that I did for this people.

Chapter 16

1 And it happened, when it was heard by Sanaballat and Tobia and Gesam the Arabi and the remaining ones of our enemies that I built the wall, no breath was left in them. Until that time I had not set doors in the gates.

2 And Sanaballat and Gesam sent to me, saying, Come, and let us gather together in the villages in the plain of Ono; and they were considering doing evil to me.

3 And I sent messengers to them, saying, I am doing a great work and will not be able to go down, lest the work stop; when I complete it, I will go down to you.

4 And they sent to me according to this word, and I sent to them according to these things.

5 And Sanaballat sent to me his servant, and an opened letter in his hand.

6 And it was written in it, It was heard among nations that you and the Jews consider rebelling; for this reason you build the wall, and you become their king;

7 and in addition to these things you stationed prophets for yourself, so that you may sit in Jerusalem as king in Judah; and now these words will be reported to the king; and now come, let us take counsel together.

8 And I sent to him, saying, It did not happen according to these words which you say, for from your heart you fabricate them.

9 For they all frighten us, saying, Their hands will grow slack from this work, and it will not be done; and now I strengthened my hands.

10 And I entered into the house of Semei son of Dalaia son of Meetabel – and he was confined – and he said, Let us gather into the house of God, into its midst, and close its doors, for they are coming at night to murder you.

11 And I said, Who is the man who will enter into the house and live?

12 And I recognized, and behold, God did not send him, for the prophecy was a word against me, and Tobias and Sanaballat hired

13 a crowd against me, so that I might fear and do thus and sin and become an evil name for them, so that they might reproach me. –

14 Remember, God, for Tobia and Sanaballat according to these deeds of his, and for Noadia the prophet and the remaining prophets who were frightening me.

15 And the wall was completed on the twenty-fifth of Eloul, in fifty-two days.

16 And it happened, when all our enemies heard, all the nations around us feared, and fear fell greatly in their eyes, and they knew that it came about from our God for this work to be completed. –

17 And in those days letters from many honored men of Judah were going to Tobia, and those of Tobia were coming to them,

18 for many in Judah were bound by oath to him, for he was son-in-law of Sechenia son of Erae, and Joanan his son took the daughter of Mesoulam son of Barachia as wife.

19 And they were saying his words to me and carrying out my words to him, and Tobias sent letters to frighten me.

Chapter 17

1 And it happened, when the wall was built, I set up the doors, and the gatekeepers and those singing and the Levites were appointed.

2 And I gave orders to Anania my brother and to Anania, ruler of the bira in Jerusalem, for he was like a truthful man and one fearing God beyond many,

3 and I said to them, The gates of Jerusalem shall not be opened until the sun is up, and while they are still watching, let the doors be closed and wedged shut; and station advance guards from those dwelling in Jerusalem, each man at his guard post and each man opposite his house.

4 And the city was broad and great, and the people few in it, and there were no houses built.

5 And God put it into my heart, and I gathered those honored and the rulers and the people into companies; and I found a book of the company, those who went up among the first, and I found written in it,

6 And these are sons of the country who went up from the captivity of the exiled community which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon exiled, and they returned to Jerusalem and to Judah, each man to his city,

7 with Zorobabel and Jesus and Neemias, Azaria, Daemia, Naemani, Mardochaios, Balsan, Maspharath, Esdras, Bagoi, Naoum, Baana, Masphar. Men of the people Israel:

8 sons of Phoros, two thousand one hundred and seventy-two.

9 Sons of Saphatia, three hundred and seventy-two.

10 Sons of Era, six hundred and fifty-two.

11 Sons of Phaathmoab, for the sons of Jesus and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and eighteen.

12 Sons of Ailam, one thousand two hundred and fifty-four.

13 Sons of Zathoua, eight hundred and forty-five.

14 Sons of Zakchou, seven hundred and sixty.

15 Sons of Banoui, six hundred and forty-eight.

16 Sons of Bebi, six hundred and twenty-eight.

17 Sons of Asgad, two thousand three hundred and twenty-two.

18 Sons of Adenikam, six hundred and sixty-seven.

19 Sons of Bagoi, two thousand and sixty-seven.

20 Sons of Edin, six hundred and fifty-five.

21 Sons of Ater, for Ezekia, ninety-eight.

22 Sons of Esam, three hundred and twenty-eight.

23 Sons of Besi, three hundred and twenty-four.

24 Sons of Ariph, one hundred and twelve.

25 Sons of Gabaon, ninety-five.

26 Sons of Bethlehem, one hundred and twenty-three. Sons of Netopha, fifty-six.

27 Sons of Anathoth, one hundred and twenty-eight.

28 Men of Bethasmoth, forty-two.

29 Men of Kariathiarim, Kaphira and Beroth, seven hundred and forty-three.

30 Men of Arama and Gabaa, six hundred and one.

31 Men of Machemas, one hundred and twenty-two.

32 Men of Bethel and Aia, one hundred and twenty-three.

33 Men of Nabi – aar, fifty-two.

34 Men of Elam – aar, one thousand two hundred and fifty-four.

35 Sons of Eram, three hundred and twenty.

36 Sons of Jericho, three hundred and forty-five.

37 Sons of Lod, Adid and Ono, seven hundred and twenty-one.

38 Sons of Sanaa, three thousand nine hundred and thirty. –

39 The priests: sons of Jodae, for the house of Jesus, nine hundred and seventy-three.

40 Sons of Emmer, one thousand and fifty-two.

41 Sons of Phassour, one thousand two hundred and forty-seven.

42 Sons of Eram, one thousand and seventeen. –

43 The Levites: sons of Jesus, for Kadmiel, for the sons of Oudouia, seventy-four.

44 Those singing: sons of Asaph, one hundred and forty-eight.

45 The gatekeepers: sons of Saloum, sons of Ater, sons of Telmon, sons of Akoub, sons of Atita, sons of Sabi, one hundred and thirty-eight. –

46 The nathinim: sons of Sea, sons of Asipha, sons of Tabaoth,

47 sons of Kiras, sons of Souia, sons of Phadon,

48 sons of Labana, sons of Agaba, sons of Salami,

49 sons of Anan, sons of Gadel, sons of Gaar,

50 sons of Raaia, sons of Rason, sons of Nekoda,

51 sons of Gezam, sons of Ozi, sons of Phese,

52 sons of Besi, sons of Meinom, sons of Nephosasim,

53 sons of Bakbouk, sons of Achipha, sons of Arour,

54 sons of Basaloth, sons of Meida, sons of Adasan,

55 sons of Barkous, sons of Sisara, sons of Thema,

56 sons of Nisia, sons of Atipha.

57 Sons of Solomon's slaves: sons of Souti, sons of Sapharath, sons of Pherida,

58 sons of Jeale, sons of Dorkon, sons of Gadel,

59 sons of Saphatia, sons of Etel, sons of Phacharath, sons of Sabaim, sons of Emim.

60 All the nathinim and sons of Solomon's slaves, three hundred and ninety-two. –

61 And these went up from Thelmeleth, Aresa, Charoub, Eron, Jemer, and could not report the houses of their ancestral families and their seed, whether they are from Israel:

62 sons of Dalaia, sons of Tobia, sons of Nekoda, six hundred and forty-two.

63 And from the priests: sons of Ebia, sons of Akos, sons of Berzelli, for he took wives from the daughters of Berzelli the Galaadite and was called by their name;

64 these sought their record of the company, and it was not found, and they were ἠγχιστεύθησαν [sense uncertain] from the priesthood,

65 and Athersatha said that they should not eat from the holy of holies until the priest arises to enlighten. –

66 And the whole assembly became as one, forty-two thousand three hundred and sixty,

67 besides their slaves and their female servants, these being seven thousand three hundred and thirty-seven; and male singers and female singers, two hundred and forty-five;

68 horses, seven hundred and thirty-six; mules, two hundred and forty-five;

69 camels, four hundred and thirty-five; donkeys, six thousand seven hundred and twenty. –

70 And some of the chiefs of the ancestral families gave for the work to Neemias, into the treasury, a thousand gold pieces, fifty bowls and thirty chothonoth of the priests.

71 And some of the chiefs of the ancestral families gave into the treasury of the work twenty thousand of gold and two thousand two hundred minas of silver,

72 and the remaining people gave twenty thousand of gold and two thousand two hundred minas of silver and sixty-seven chothonoth of the priests. –

73 And the priests and the Levites and the gatekeepers and those singing and those from the people and the nathinim and all Israel settled in their cities. And the seventh month arrived – and the sons of Israel were in their cities –

Chapter 18

1 and all the people gathered as one man into the broad space in front of the water gate. And they told Esdras the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the Lord commanded Israel.

2 And Esdras the priest brought the law before the assembly, from man to woman, and everyone understanding to hear, on the first day of the seventh month,

3 and he read in it from the hour when the sun shines through until the middle of the day, before the men and the women, and they were understanding, and the ears of all the people were toward the book of the law.

4 And Esdras the scribe stood upon a wooden platform, and beside him stood Mattathias and Samaias and Ananias and Ouria and Elkia and Maasaia on his right, and on the left Phadaias and Misael and Melchias and Osam and Asabdana and Zacharias and Mosollam.

5 And Esdras opened the book before all the people – for he was above the people – and it happened, when he opened it, all the people stood.

6 And Esdras blessed the Lord, the great God, and all the people answered and said, Amen, lifting their hands, and they bent down and worshiped the Lord upon their face on the earth.

7 And Jesus and Banaias and Sarabia were instructing the people in the law, and the people were at their station.

8 And they read in the book of the law of God, and Esdras taught and explained distinctly in knowledge of the Lord, and the people understood in the reading. –

9 And Neemias and Esdras the priest and scribe and the Levites instructing the people spoke and said to all the people, The day is holy to the Lord our God; do not mourn or weep; for all the people were weeping when they heard the words of the law.

10 And he said to them, Go, eat rich foods and drink sweet drinks and send portions to those who do not have, for the day is holy to our Lord; and do not fall apart, for it is your strength.

11 And the Levites were quieting all the people, saying, Be silent, for the day is holy, and do not fall down.

12 And all the people went away to eat and drink and send portions and make great rejoicing, for they understood the words which he made known to them.

13 And on the second day the rulers of the ancestral families for all the people, the priests and the Levites, gathered to Esdras the scribe to attend to all the words of the law.

14 And they found written in the law which the Lord commanded Moses, that the sons of Israel should dwell in tents during a feast in the seventh month,

15 and that they should signal with trumpets in all their cities and in Jerusalem. And Esdras said, Go out to the mountain and bring olive leaves and leaves of cypress trees and myrtle leaves and palm leaves and leaves of a dense tree, to make tents according to what is written.

16 And the people went out and brought them and made tents for themselves, each man upon his roof, and in their courts and in the courts of the house of God and in the squares of the city and as far as the gate of Ephraim.

17 And the whole assembly, those returning from the captivity, made tents and settled in tents; for from the days of Jesus son of Naue the sons of Israel had not done so until that day; and there was great rejoicing.

18 And he read in the book of the law of God day by day, from the first day until the last day; and they held a feast for seven days, and on the eighth day a closing observance according to the judgment.

Chapter 19

1 And on the twenty-fourth day of this month the sons of Israel gathered in fasting and in sackcloth.

2 And the sons of Israel separated themselves from every foreign son and stood and confessed their sins and the lawless deeds of their fathers.

3 And they stood at their station and read in the book of the law of the Lord their God, and they were confessing to the Lord and worshiping the Lord their God.

4 And on the ascent of the Levites stood Jesus and sons of Kadmiel, Sachania son of Sarabia, sons of Chanani, and they cried with a great voice to the Lord their God.

5 And the Levites Jesus and Kadmiel said, Arise, bless the Lord your God from age to age, and they will bless the name of your glory and exalt it above every blessing and praise.

6 And Esdras said, You yourself alone are Lord; you made heaven and the heaven of heaven and all their array, the earth and all that is in it, the seas and all that is in them, and you give life to all things, and the armies of the heavens worship you.

7 You are the Lord God; you made your choice in Abram and brought him out of the country of the Chaldeans and placed upon him the name Abraham;

8 and you found his heart faithful before you and made a covenant with him to give him the land of the Chananites and Chettites and Amorrites and Pherezites and Jebousites and Gergesites, and to his seed; and you established your words, for you are righteous.

9 And you saw the humiliation of our fathers in Egypt and heard their cry at the Red Sea.

10 And you gave signs in Egypt, in Pharaoh and in all his servants and in all the people of his land, for you knew that they acted arrogantly against them, and you made a name for yourself, as this day.

11 And you broke open the sea before them, and they passed through the midst of the sea on dry ground, and those pursuing them you threw into the deep like a stone in mighty water.

12 And in a pillar of cloud you guided them by day, and in a pillar of fire by night, to light for them the way in which they will travel.

13 And you descended upon Mount Sina and spoke to them from heaven and gave them upright judgments and laws of truth, good ordinances and commandments.

14 And you made known to them your holy sabbath; commandments and ordinances and law you commanded them by the hand of Moses your slave.

15 And you gave them bread from heaven for their lack of grain and brought out water from rock for them for their thirst. And you told them to enter to inherit the land concerning which you stretched out your hand to give it to them.

16 And they and our fathers acted arrogantly and hardened their neck and did not hear your commandments;

17 and they refused to listen and did not remember your wonders which you did with them, and they hardened their neck and gave a beginning to return to their slavery in Egypt. And you are a merciful and compassionate God, long-suffering and abundant in mercy, and you did not abandon them.

18 And moreover they also made themselves a cast calf and said, These are the gods who brought us out of Egypt; and they made great provocations to anger.

19 And you in your many compassions did not abandon them in the wilderness; you did not turn away from them the pillar of cloud by day to guide them in the way, and the pillar of fire by night to light for them the way in which they will travel.

20 And you gave your good spirit to instruct them, and you did not withhold your manna from their mouth, and you gave them water for their thirst.

21 And forty years you nourished them in the wilderness; they did not lack; their garments did not grow old, and their feet did not split open.

22 And you gave them kingdoms and peoples and divided them for them, and they inherited the land of Seon king of Esebon and the land of Og king of Basan.

23 And you multiplied their sons like the stars of heaven and brought them into the land which you spoke of to their fathers, and they inherited it.

24 And you wiped out before them those dwelling in the land of the Chananites and gave them into their hands, and their kings and the peoples of the land, to do to them as was pleasing before them.

25 And they seized high cities and inherited houses full of all good things, hewn pits, vineyards and olive groves and every tree for food in abundance; and they ate and were filled and grew fat and lived luxuriously in your great goodness.

26 And they changed and departed from you and threw your law behind their body and killed your prophets, who testified among them to turn them toward you, and they made great provocations to anger.

27 And you gave them into the hand of those afflicting them, and they afflicted them; and they cried out to you at the time of their affliction, and you heard from your heaven and in your great compassions gave them saviors and saved them from the hand of those afflicting them.

28 And when they rested, they turned back to do evil before you; and you abandoned them into the hands of their enemies, and they ruled over them. And again they cried out to you, and you listened from heaven and rescued them in your many compassions.

29 And you testified to them to turn them to your law, and they did not hear, but in your commandments and in your judgments they sinned, which, if a man does them, he will live in them; and they gave a disobedient back and hardened their neck and did not hear.

30 And you prolonged matters over them for many years and testified to them by your spirit through the hand of your prophets; and they did not give ear, and you gave them into the hand of peoples of the land.

31 And you in your many compassions did not make an end of them and did not abandon them, for you are strong and merciful and compassionate.

32 And now, our God, the strong, the great, the mighty and the fearsome, keeping your covenant and your mercy, let not all the hardship be made little before you which found us and our kings and our rulers and our priests and our prophets and our fathers, and among all your people, from the days of kings of Assour and until this day.

33 And you are righteous in all things coming upon us, for you acted in truth, and we sinned.

34 And our kings and our rulers and our priests and our fathers did not do your law and did not attend to your commandments and your testimonies which you testified to them.

35 And they in your kingdom and in your abundant goodness which you gave them, and in the broad and rich land which you gave before them, did not serve you and did not turn away from their evil practices.

36 Behold, today we are slaves, and the land which you gave our fathers to eat its fruit,

37 is for the kings whom you gave over us in our sins, and they exercise authority over our bodies and over our beasts as is pleasing to them, and we are in great affliction.

Chapter 20

1 And in all these things we make a pledge of faithfulness and write, and all our rulers, our Levites, our priests affix seals.

2 And among those sealing were Neemias son of Achalia and Sedekias

3 son of Saraia, and Azaria and Jermia,

4 Phasour, Amaria, Melchia,

5 Atous, Sebani, Malouch,

6 Iram, Meramoth, Abdia,

7 Daniel, Ganathon, Barouch,

8 Mesoulam, Abia, Miamin,

9 Maazia, Belgai, Samaia; these were priests;

10 and the Levites, Jesus son of Azania, Banaiou from the sons of Enadad, Kadmiel

11 and his brothers, Sabania, Odouia, Kalita, Pheleia, Anan,

12 Micha, Roob, Esebias,

13 Zachor, Sarabia, Sebania,

14 Odouia, sons of Banounai;

15 rulers of the people, Phoros, Phaathmoab, Elam, Zathouia, sons of

16 Bani, Asgad, Bebai,

17 Edania, Bagoi, Edin,

18 Ater, Ezekia, Azour,

19 Odouia, Esam, Besi,

20 Ariph, Anathoth, Nobai,

21 Magaphes, Mesoulam, Ezir,

22 Mesozebel, Saddouk, Jeddoua,

23 Phaltia, Anan, Anaia,

24 Osee, Anania, Asoub,

25 Aloes, Phalai, Sobek,

26 Raoum, Esabana, Maasaia

27 and Aia, Ainan, Enan,

28 Malouch, Eram, Baana.

29 And the remaining people, the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, those singing, the nathinim and everyone coming from peoples of the land toward the law of God, their wives, their sons, their daughters, everyone knowing and understanding,

30 were strengthening themselves against their brothers, cursed them and entered into a curse and into an oath to walk in the law of God which was given by the hand of Moses the slave of God, and to keep and do all the commandments of our Lord and his judgments,

31 and not to give our daughters to the peoples of the land, and we will not take their daughters for our sons.

32 And the peoples of the land who bring merchandise and every article for sale on the sabbath day to sell, we do not buy from them on the sabbath and on a holy day. And we will release the seventh year and the exaction of every hand.

33 And we will establish commandments upon ourselves, to impose upon ourselves the giving of a third of the didrachm each year for the service of the house of our God,

34 for bread of the presence and the continual sacrifice and for the continual whole burnt offering of the sabbaths, of the new moons, for the feasts and for the holy things, and the offerings for sin to make atonement for Israel, and for works of the house of our God.

35 And we cast lots concerning the lot of wood-bearing, the priests and the Levites and the people, to bring it into the house of our God, by house of our ancestral families, at appointed times, year by year, to burn upon the altar of the Lord our God, as it is written in the law,

36 and to bring the first produce of our land and the first produce of the fruit of every tree, year by year, into the house of the Lord,

37 and the firstborn of our sons and of our beasts, as it is written in the law, and the firstborn of our cattle and our flocks, to bring into the house of our God to the priests ministering in the house of our God.

38 And the first portion of our grain and the fruit of every tree, of wine and of oil, we will bring to the priests into the treasury of the house of God; and a tenth of our land to the Levites. And the Levites themselves collect tithes in all the cities of our service,

39 and the priest, a son of Aaron, shall be with the Levite at the Levite's tithe, and the Levites will bring up the tenth of the tenth into the house of our God, into the treasuries, into the house of God.

40 For into the treasuries the sons of Israel and the sons of Levi will bring the first portions of grain and of wine and of oil, and there are the holy vessels and the priests who minister and the gatekeepers and those singing. And we will not abandon the house of our God.

Chapter 21

1 And the rulers of the people settled in Jerusalem, and the remaining people cast lots to bring one out of ten to settle in Jerusalem, the holy city, and nine portions in the cities.

2 And the people blessed all the men volunteering to settle in Jerusalem.

3 And these are the rulers of the country who settled in Jerusalem; and in the cities of Judah they settled, each man in his possession in their cities, Israel, the priests and the Levites and the nathinaians and the sons of Solomon's slaves;

4 and in Jerusalem some of the sons of Judah and some of the sons of Benjamin settled. – From the sons of Judah: Athaia son of Azaia son of Zacharia son of Amaria son of Saphatia son of Malelel, and from the sons of Phares.

5 And Maasia son of Barouch son of Chalaza son of Ozia son of Adaia son of Jorib son of Thezia son of the Seloni.

6 All the sons of Phares dwelling in Jerusalem, four hundred and sixty-eight men of strength. –

7 And these are sons of Benjamin: Selo son of Mesoulam son of Joad son of Phadaia son of Kolia son of Masaia son of Aithiel son of Jesia;

8 and behind him Gebi, Seli, nine hundred and twenty-eight.

9 And Joel son of Zechri was overseer over them, and Judas son of Asana was second over the city. –

10 From the priests: also Jadia son of Jorib, Jachin,

11 Saraia son of Elkia son of Mesoulam son of Saddouk son of Marioth son of Aitob, opposite the house of God.

12 And their brothers doing the work of the house: Amasi son of Zacharia son of Phassour son of Melchia,

13 rulers of ancestral families, two hundred and forty-two. And Amessai son of Esdriel,

14 and his brothers, mighty in battle array, one hundred and twenty-eight, and overseer over them, Badiel. –

15 And from the Levites, Samaia son of Asoub son of Ezri

17 and Mathania son of Micha and Obed son of Samoui,

18 two hundred and eighty-four.

19 And the gatekeepers Akoub, Telamin, and their brothers, one hundred and seventy-two.

22 And an overseer of Levites was a son of Bani, Ozi son of Asabia son of Micha. From the sons of Asaph, those singing opposite the work of the house of God;

23 for the king's commandment was upon them.

24 And Pathaia son of Baseza was at the king's hand for every matter concerning the people. –

25 And toward the settlements in their field. And some of the sons of Judah settled in Kariatharbok

26 and in Jesou

27 and in Beersabee,

30 and their settlements, Lachis and her fields; and they encamped in Beersabee.

31 And the sons of Benjamin were from Gaba, Machamas.

36 And from the Levites, portions of Judah for Benjamin.

Chapter 22

1 And these are the priests and the Levites going up with Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus: Saraia, Jermia, Esdras,

2 Amaria, Malouch,

3 Sechenia;

7 these were rulers of the priests and their brothers in the days of Jesus. –

8 And the Levites: Jesou, Banoui, Kadmiel, Sarabia, Judah, Machania; over the hands, he and his brothers,

9 for the daily divisions.

10 And Jesus begot Joakim, and Joakim begot Eliasib, and Eliasib, Jodae,

11 and Jodae begot Jonathan, and Jonathan begot Jadou.

12 And in the days of Joakim, his brothers the priests and the rulers of the ancestral families: for Saraia, Maraia; for Jermia, Anania;

13 for Esdras, Mesoulam; for Amaria, Joanan;

14 for Malouch, Jonathan; for Sechenia, Joseph;

15 for Arem, Adnas; for Marioth, Elkai;

16 for Addai, Zacharias; for Ganathon, Mosollam;

17 for Abia, Zechri; for Benjamin, at times, for Pheleti;

18 for Balga, Samoue; for Semeia, Jonathan;

19 for Joiarib, Maththanai; for Idia, Ozi;

20 for Sallai, Kallai; for Amouk, Abed;

21 for Elkia, Asabias; for Jedeiou, Nathanael. –

22 The Levites in the days of Eliasib, Joada and Joanan and Idoua were recorded as rulers of ancestral families, and the priests in the reign of Darius the Persian;

23 sons of Levi, rulers of the ancestral families, recorded in the book of words of the days, even until the days of Joanan son of Elisoub.

24 And rulers of the Levites: Asabia and Sarabia and Jesou and sons of Kadmiel and their brothers opposite them, to sing hymns and praise by the commandment of David the man of God, daily division against daily division,

25 when I gathered the gatekeepers,

26 in the days of Joakim son of Jesus son of Josedek and in the days of Neemias, and Esdras the priest, the scribe.

27 And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites in their places to bring them into Jerusalem to make a dedication and rejoicing with thodatha and with songs, sounding cymbals, and psalteries and lyres.

28 And the sons of those singing gathered, also from the surrounding district round about into Jerusalem, and from settlements

29 and from fields; for those singing built settlements for themselves in Jerusalem.

30 And the priests and the Levites were cleansed, and they cleansed the people and the gatekeepers and the wall.

31 And I brought up the rulers of Judah upon the wall and stationed two great ones for praise, and they passed on the right upon the wall of the dung,

32 and Osaia and half the rulers of Judah went behind them,

33 and Azarias, Esdras and Mesoulam,

34 Judah and Benjamin and Samaia and Jermia,

35 and from the sons of the priests, with trumpets, Zacharias son of Jonathan son of Samaia son of Mathania son of Michaia son of Zakchour son of Asaph,

36 and his brothers Samaia and Oziel, to praise with songs of David the man of God, and Esdras the scribe in front of them;

37 at the gate of ain opposite them they went up upon the stairs of the city of David, at the ascent of the wall above the house of David and as far as the water gate eastward. –

38 And the second one for praise was going to meet them, and I behind it, and half the people upon the wall above the tower of the thennourim and as far as the broad wall,

39 and above the gate of Ephraim and to the gate of isana and to the fish gate and at the tower of Ananeel and as far as the sheep gate, and they stood at the gate of the guard.

40 And the two of praise stood in the house of God, and I and half the generals with me,

41 and the priests Eliakim, Maasias, Benjamin, Michaias, Elioenai, Zacharias, Ananias, with trumpets,

42 and Maasias and Semeias and Eleazar and Ozi and Joanan and Melchias and Ailam and Ezour, and those singing were heard and were appointed.

43 And on that day they sacrificed great sacrifices and rejoiced, for God made them rejoice greatly; and their wives and their children rejoiced, and the rejoicing in Jerusalem was heard from far away.

44 And on that day they appointed men over the treasuries for the stores, the first portions and the tithes, and for the rulers of the cities gathered in them, portions for the priests and for the Levites, for there was rejoicing in Judah over the priests and over the Levites standing there.

45 And they kept the watches of their God and the watches of purification, and those singing and the gatekeepers, according to the commandments of David and Solomon his son;

46 for in the days of David, Asaph from the beginning was first of those singing, and a hymn and praise to God,

47 and all Israel in the days of Zorobabel were giving portions of those singing and of the gatekeepers, a day's matter on its day, and consecrating for the Levites, and the Levites consecrating for the sons of Aaron.

Chapter 23

1 On that day it was read in the book of Moses in the ears of the people, and it was found written in it that Ammanites and Moabites should not enter into the assembly of God forever,

2 for they did not meet the sons of Israel with bread and with water, and they hired Balaam against him to curse, and our God turned the curse into a blessing.

3 And it happened, when they heard the law, every mixed person in Israel was separated.

4 And before this Eliasib the priest, dwelling in a treasury of the house of our God, being near Tobia,

5 made him a great treasury, and there they had formerly been putting the manaan and the frankincense and the vessels and the tenth of grain and of wine and of oil, the commandment of the Levites and of those singing and of the gatekeepers, and first portions of the priests.

6 And during all this I was not in Jerusalem, for in the thirty-second year of Arthasastha king of Babylon I came to the king. And after the end of days I made a request of the king

7 and came into Jerusalem. And I understood the evil which Elisoub did for Tobia, to make him a treasury in the court of the house of God.

8 And it appeared very evil to me, and I threw all the vessels of Tobia's house outside, out of the treasury;

9 and I spoke, and they cleansed the treasuries, and I returned there the vessels of the house of God, the manaa and the frankincense.

10 And I knew that the portions of the Levites had not been given, and the Levites and those singing who were doing the work fled, each man to his field.

11 And I contended with the generals and said, Why was the house of God abandoned? And I gathered them and stationed them at their station.

12 And all Judah brought a tenth of the wheat and of the wine and of the oil into the stores,

13 at the hand of Selemia the priest and Saddouk the scribe and Phadaia from the Levites, and at their hand Anan son of Zakchour son of Mathania, for they were reckoned faithful, to distribute to their brothers.

14 Remember me, God, in this, and let not my mercy be wiped out, which I did in the house of the Lord God.

15 In those days I saw in Judah people treading winepresses on the sabbath and bringing sheaves and loading them upon the donkeys, and wine and grapes and figs and every burden, and bringing them into Jerusalem on the sabbath day; and I testified on the day of their selling.

16 And they settled in it, bringing fish and every article for sale, selling on the sabbath to the sons of Judah and in Jerusalem.

17 And I contended with the free sons of Judah and said to them, What is this evil matter which you do and profane the sabbath day?

18 Did not your fathers act so? And our God brought all these evils upon them and upon us and upon this city; and you add wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.

19 And it happened, when the gates of Jerusalem were set in place before the sabbath, I spoke and they closed the gates, and I said that they should not be opened until after the sabbath; and some of my young servants I stationed at the gates so that burdens should not be lifted on the sabbath day.

20 And they all lodged and carried on selling outside Jerusalem once and twice.

21 And I testified among them and said to them, Why do you lodge opposite the wall? If you do it a second time, I will stretch out my hand against you. From that time they did not come on the sabbath.

22 And I told the Levites, who were cleansing themselves and coming to guard the gates, to sanctify the sabbath day. For these things remember me, God, and spare me according to the abundance of your mercy.

23 And in those days I saw the Jews who settled Azotian, Ammanite, Moabite wives,

24 and their sons, half speaking Azotian, and they do not know how to speak Judean,

25 and I contended with them and cursed them and struck men among them and pulled out their hair and made them swear by God, If you give your daughters to their sons, and if you take from their daughters for your sons.

26 Did not Solomon king of Israel sin so? And among many nations there was no king like him; and he was loved by God, and God made him king over all Israel. And the foreign wives turned even this man aside.

27 And shall we not hear of you doing all this evil, acting faithlessly toward our God, settling foreign wives? –

28 And from the sons of Joada, of Elisoub the great priest, son-in-law of Sanaballat the Oronite, and I drove him out from me.

29 Remember for them, God, concerning the kinship of the priesthood and the covenant of the priesthood, and the Levites. –

30 And I cleansed them from every foreign association and stationed daily divisions for the priests and for the Levites, each man according to his work,

31 and the gift of the wood-bearers at appointed times and among the bakchouria. Remember me, our God, for goodness.

Ezra

Chapter 1

1 And in the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, so that the word of the Lord from the mouth of Jeremias would be fulfilled, the Lord stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of the Persians, and he ordered a proclamation throughout his kingdom, indeed also in writing, saying,

2 Thus said Cyrus king of the Persians: The Lord, the God of heaven, gave me all the kingdoms of the earth, and he charged me to build him a house in Jerusalem in Judea.

3 Who among you is of all his people? And his God shall be with him, and he shall go up to Jerusalem in Judea, and let him build the house of the God of Israel [he is the God in Jerusalem].

4 And everyone remaining from all the places where he himself sojourns, the men of his place shall take him up with silver and gold and equipment and livestock, together with the voluntary offering for the house of God in Jerusalem.—

5 And the rulers of the families of Judah and Benjamin and the priests and the Levites arose, of all whose spirit God stirred to go up to build the house of the Lord in Jerusalem.

6 And all those round about strengthened their hands with vessels of silver, with gold, with equipment and livestock and gifts, apart from the voluntary offerings.

7 And King Cyrus brought out the vessels of the house of the Lord which Nabouchodonosor took from Jerusalem and placed in the house of his god,

8 and Cyrus king of the Persians brought them out into the hand of Mithradates the gasbarenos, and he counted them for Sasabasar ruler of Judah.

9 And this is their number: thirty gold cooling vessels and a thousand silver cooling vessels, twenty-nine assorted items,

10 thirty gold kephphoure and two hundred silver ones, and a thousand other vessels.

11 All the vessels of gold and silver, five thousand four hundred, all going up with Sasabasar from the deportation, from Babylon to Jerusalem.

Chapter 2

1 And these are the sons of the country going up from the captivity of the deportation which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon deported to Babylon, and they returned to Jerusalem and Judah, each man to his city,

2 who came with Zorobabel: Jesus, Neemias, Saraias, Reelias, Mardochaios, Balasan, Masphar, Bagoui, Reoum, Baana. The number of men of the people of Israel:

3 sons of Phoros, two thousand one hundred seventy-two.

4 Sons of Saphatia, three hundred seventy-two.

5 Sons of Era, seven hundred seventy-five.

6 Sons of Phaathmoab belonging to the sons of Jesoue Joab, two thousand eight hundred twelve.

7 Sons of Ailam, one thousand two hundred fifty-four.

8 Sons of Zathoua, nine hundred forty-five.

9 Sons of Zakchou, seven hundred sixty.

10 Sons of Banoui, six hundred forty-two.

11 Sons of Babi, six hundred twenty-three.

12 Sons of Asgad, three thousand two hundred twenty-two.

13 Sons of Adonikam, six hundred sixty-six.

14 Sons of Bagoi, two thousand fifty-six.

15 Sons of Adin, four hundred fifty-four.

16 Sons of Ater belonging to Ezekias, ninety-eight.

17 Sons of Basou, three hundred twenty-three.

18 Sons of Jora, one hundred twelve.

19 Sons of Asem, two hundred twenty-three.

20 Sons of Gaber, ninety-five.

21 Sons of Bethlehem, one hundred twenty-three.

22 Sons of Netopha, fifty-six.

23 Sons of Anathoth, one hundred twenty-eight.

24 Sons of Asmoth, forty-two.

25 Sons of Kariathiarim, Kaphira and Beroth, seven hundred forty-three.

26 Sons of Arama and Gabaa, six hundred twenty-one.

27 Men of Machmas, one hundred twenty-two.

28 Men of Baithel and Aia, four hundred twenty-three.

29 Sons of Nabou, fifty-two.

30 Sons of Magebos, one hundred fifty-six.

31 Sons of Elam—ar, one thousand two hundred fifty-four.

32 Sons of Eram, three hundred twenty.

33 Sons of Lod, Aroth and Ono, seven hundred twenty-five.

34 Sons of Jericho, three hundred forty-five.

35 Sons of Sanaa, three thousand six hundred thirty.—

36 And the priests: sons of Jedoua belonging to the house of Jesus, nine hundred seventy-three.

37 Sons of Emmer, one thousand fifty-two.

38 Sons of Phassour, one thousand two hundred forty-seven.

39 Sons of Erem, one thousand seven.—

40 And the Levites: sons of Jesus and Kadmiel belonging to the sons of Odouia, seventy-four.

41 The singers: sons of Asaph, one hundred twenty-eight.

42 Sons of the gatekeepers: sons of Saloum, sons of Ater, sons of Telmon, sons of Akoub, sons of Atita, sons of Sabaou, all one hundred thirty-nine.—

43 The Nathinaioi: sons of Souia, sons of Asouphe, sons of Tabaoth,

44 sons of Keraos, sons of Soea, sons of Phadon,

45 sons of Labano, sons of Agaba, sons of Akaboth,

46 sons of Agab, sons of Samalai, sons of Anan,

47 sons of Kedel, sons of Gaer, sons of Reea,

48 sons of Rason, sons of Nekoda, sons of Gazem,

49 sons of Ousa, sons of Phase, sons of Basi,

50 sons of Asena, sons of Maonim, sons of Naphison,

51 sons of Bakbouk, sons of Akipha, sons of Arour,

52 sons of Basaloth, sons of Maouda, sons of Aresa,

53 sons of Barkous, sons of Sisara, sons of Thema,

54 sons of Nasoue, sons of Atoupha.

55 Sons of Abdeselma: sons of Sati, sons of Asepherath, sons of Phadoura,

56 sons of Jeela, sons of Darkon, sons of Gedel,

57 sons of Saphatia, sons of Atil, sons of Phacherath—aseboin, sons of Emi.

58 All the Nathinin and sons of Abdeselma, three hundred ninety-two.—

59 And these are those who came up from Thelmeleth, Thelaresa, Charoub, Edan, Emmer, and they were unable to declare their family house and their seed, whether they are from Israel:

60 sons of Dalaia, sons of Boua, sons of Tobia, sons of Nekoda, six hundred fifty-two.

61 And from the sons of the priests: sons of Chabia, sons of Akous, sons of Berzellai, who took a wife from the daughters of Berzellai the Galaadite and was called by their name;

62 these, the methoesim sought their record, and they were not found; and they were ἠγχιστεύθησαν [sense uncertain] from the priesthood,

63 and Athersatha told them not to eat from the holy of holies until a priest should arise with the enlightening things and the perfect things.—

64 And the whole assembly as one, forty-two thousand three hundred sixty,

65 apart from their slaves and their female servants, these seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven; and these male singers and female singers, two hundred;

66 their horses, seven hundred thirty-six, their mules, two hundred forty-five,

67 their camels, four hundred thirty-five, their asses, six thousand seven hundred twenty.—

68 And some of the rulers of families, when they came to the house of the Lord in Jerusalem, made voluntary offerings for the house of God, to establish it upon its prepared site;

69 according to their ability they gave to the treasury of the work pure gold, sixty-one thousand minas, and silver, five thousand minas, and a hundred kothonoi of the priests.—

70 And the priests and the Levites and those from the people and the singers and the gatekeepers and the Nathinim settled in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

Chapter 3

1 And the seventh month arrived—and the sons of Israel were in their cities—and the people gathered as one man in Jerusalem.

2 And Jesus son of Josedek and his brothers the priests and Zorobabel son of Salathiel and his brothers arose and built the altar of the God of Israel, to offer whole burnt offerings upon it according to the things written in the law of Moses, the man of God.

3 And they prepared the altar upon its prepared site, because terror was upon them from the peoples of the lands, and a whole burnt offering to the Lord went up upon it in the morning and toward evening.

4 And they kept the feast of tents according to what was written, and whole burnt offerings day by day, in number according to the ordinance, the requirement of a day on its day,

5 and after this continual whole burnt offerings, and for the new moons and for all the sanctified feasts, and for everyone voluntarily offering a voluntary offering to the Lord.

6 On day one of the seventh month they began to offer whole burnt offerings to the Lord; and the house of the Lord had not been founded.

7 And they gave silver to the stonecutters and carpenters, and food and drink and oil to the Sedanin and the Sorin, to bring cedar timber from Lebanon to the sea of Joppe, according to the concession of Cyrus king of the Persians to them.—

8 And in the second year of their coming to the house of God in Jerusalem, in the second month, Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek and the remaining ones of their brothers, the priests and the Levites, and all those coming from the captivity to Jerusalem began, and they stationed the Levites from twenty years old and upward over those doing the works in the house of the Lord.

9 And Jesus and his sons and his brothers, Kadmiel and his sons, sons of Judah, stood over those doing the works in the house of God, sons of Enadad, their sons and their brothers, the Levites.

10 And they laid foundations to build the house of the Lord, and the priests stood robed with trumpets, and the Levites, sons of Asaph, with cymbals, to praise the Lord according to the hands of David king of Israel,

11 and they answered in praise and thanksgiving to the Lord, because it is good, because his mercy upon Israel is for the age. And all the people sounded a great voice to praise the Lord at the foundation of the house of the Lord.

12 And many from the priests and the Levites and rulers of the families, the elders who saw the first house at its foundation and this house with their eyes, were weeping with a great voice, and a crowd with shouting and gladness raised a song;

13 and the people were not distinguishing the sound of the shout of gladness from the sound of the people's weeping, because the people cried out with a great voice, and the sound was heard even from afar.

Chapter 4

1 And those afflicting Judah and Benjamin heard that the sons of the deportation were building a house for the Lord, the God of Israel,

2 and approached Zorobabel and the rulers of the families and said to them, We shall build with you, because like you we seek your God, and we sacrifice to him since the days of Asaraddon king of Assour, who brought us here.

3 And Zorobabel and Jesus and the remaining rulers of the families of Israel said to them, It is not for us and you to build a house for our God, because we ourselves together shall build for the Lord our God, as Cyrus king of the Persians commanded us.

4 And the people of the land were weakening the hands of the people of Judah, and they were hindering them from building,

5 and hiring those deliberating against them to scatter their counsel all the days of Cyrus king of the Persians and until the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

6 And in the reign of Asoueros, at the beginning of his reign, they wrote a letter against those dwelling in Judah and Jerusalem.

7 And in the days of Arthasastha, Tabeel wrote in peace to Mithradates, together also with his other fellow servants, to Arthasastha king of the Persians; the tax collector wrote a writing in Syrian and translated.

8 Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe wrote one letter against Jerusalem to King Arthasastha.

9 These things Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe and our remaining fellow servants determined, Dinaioi, Apharsathachaioi, Tarphallaioi, Apharsaioi, Archyaioi, Babylonians, Sousanachaioi [who are Elamites],

10 and the remaining ones of the nations whom the great and honored Asennaphar deported and settled in the cities of Somoron, and the remnant beyond the river;

11 this is the arrangement of the letter which they sent to him: To King Arthasastha, your servants, men beyond the river.

12 Let it be known to the king that the Judeans who came up from you to us came to Jerusalem; they are building the rebellious and evil city, and they have repaired its walls and raised its foundations.

13 Now therefore let it be known to the king that if that city is rebuilt and its walls repaired, there will be no tribute for you, nor will they give it; and this harms kings.

14 And it is not permitted for us to see the king's disgrace; because of this we sent and made known to the king,

15 that he may examine the book of the record of your fathers, and you will find and know that that city is a rebellious city and harms kings and countries, and there have been flights of slaves in its midst from times of old; because of these things this city was desolated.

16 We therefore make known to the king that if that city is built and its walls repaired, there is no peace for you.

17 And the king sent peace to Raoum baaltam and Samsai the scribe and their remaining fellow servants dwelling in Samaria and the remaining ones beyond the river, and says,

18 The tax collector whom you sent to us was called before me.

19 And a decision was issued by me, and we examined and found that that city rises against kings from days of old, and rebellions and flights occur in it,

20 and strong kings arise over Jerusalem and rule all the west of the river, and full tribute and a portion are given to them.

21 And now issue a decision to stop those men, and that city shall no longer be built, so that according to the decision

22 you may be on guard against allowing relaxation in this matter, lest destruction multiply to the harm of kings.

23 Then the tax collector of King Arthasastha read before Raoum and Samsai the scribe and their fellow servants; and they went in haste to Jerusalem and into Judah and stopped them with horses and force.

24 Then the work of the house of God in Jerusalem ceased, and was idle until the second year of the reign of Darius king of the Persians.

Chapter 5

1 And Angaios the prophet and Zacharias son of Addo prophesied a prophecy to the Judeans in Judah and Jerusalem in the name of the God of Israel over them.

2 Then Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus son of Josedek arose and began to build the house of God in Jerusalem, and with them were the prophets of God, helping them.

3 At that very time Thanthanai governor beyond the river and Satharbouzana and their fellow servants came against them and said such things to them: Who issued you a decision to build this house and complete this provision?

4 Then they said these things to them: What are the names of the men building this city?

5 And the eyes of God were upon the captivity of Judah, and they did not stop them until a decision was carried to Darius; and then a message was sent to the tax collector concerning this.

6 A transcript of the letter which Thanthanai governor beyond the river and Satharbouzana and their fellow servants, the Apharsachaioi beyond the river, sent to King Darius;

7 they sent a statement to him, and these things are written in it: To King Darius, all peace.

8 Let it be known to the king that we went into the country of Judea, to the house of the great God, and it is being built with choice stones, and timber is being placed in the walls, and that work is being done skillfully and prospers in their hands.

9 Then we questioned those elders and said thus to them, Who issued you a decision to build this house and complete this provision?

10 And we asked them their names to make known to you, so as to write to you the names of the men who are their rulers.

11 And they answered us with such a statement, saying, We are slaves of the God of heaven and earth, and we are building the house which had been built many years before this, and a great king of Israel built it and completed it

12 for them. But from the time when our fathers provoked the God of heaven to anger, he gave them into the hands of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, the Chaldean, and he demolished this house and deported the people to Babylon.

13 But in the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus issued a decision that this house of God should be built.

14 And the vessels of the house of God, the gold and silver ones, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and carried away to the king's temple, King Cyrus brought out of the king's temple and gave to Sasabasar the treasurer over the treasury,

15 and said to him, Take all the vessels and go, place them in the house in Jerusalem in their own place.

16 Then that Sasabasar came and laid foundations of the house of God in Jerusalem; and from then until now it has been built and has not been completed.

17 And now, if it is good to the king, let an examination be made in the treasury house of the king of Babylon, so that you may know that a decision was issued by King Cyrus to build that house of God in Jerusalem; and when the king knows concerning this, let him send to us.

Chapter 6

1 Then King Darius issued a decision and examined in the libraries where the treasure is laid in Babylon.

2 And in a city, in the fortress of the city of the Medes, one scroll was found, and this was written in it: Memorandum:

3 In the first year of King Cyrus, King Cyrus issued a decision concerning the house of God in Jerusalem: Let a house be built, and a place where they sacrifice the sacrifices; and he set an elevation, a height of sixty cubits, its width sixty cubits;

4 and three strong stone courses and one wooden course; and the expense shall be given from the king's house;

5 and the vessels of the house of God, the silver and gold ones, which Nabouchodonosor brought out of the house in Jerusalem and conveyed to Babylon, let them be given and go to the temple in Jerusalem, to the place where they were placed in the house of God.

6 Now you shall give, governors beyond the river, Satharbouzana and their fellow servants, the Apharsachaioi beyond the river, being far from there,

7 leave the work of the house of God alone; let the leaders of the Judeans and the elders of the Judeans build that house of God upon its site.

8 And a decision was issued by me that you should never do anything with the elders of the Judeans toward building that house of God; and from the king's possessions, the tributes beyond the river, let expenses be diligently given to those men, so that it may not be stopped;

9 and whatever deficiency there may be, both offspring of oxen and rams and lambs for whole burnt offerings to the God of heaven, wheat, salt, wine, oil, according to the word of the priests in Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day, whatever they ask,

10 so that they may offer sweet smells to the God of heaven and pray for the life of the king and his sons.

11 And a decision was issued by me that every man who changes this word, a timber shall be taken down from his house, and he shall be raised upright and fixed upon it, and his house shall be dealt with according to me.

12 And God, whose name dwells there, will overthrow every king and people who stretches out his hand to change or destroy that house of God in Jerusalem. I, Darius, issued a decision; it shall be done diligently.

13 Then Thanthanai governor beyond the river, Satharbouzana and his fellow servants did thus diligently according to what King Darius sent.

14 And the elders of the Judeans were building, and the Levites, through the prophecy of Angaios the prophet and Zacharias son of Addo, and they rebuilt and completed it by the decision of the God of Israel and by the decision of Cyrus and Darius and Arthasastha, kings of the Persians.

15 And they completed this house by the third day of the month Adar, which is the sixth year of the reign of King Darius.

16 And the sons of Israel, the priests and the Levites and the remaining sons of the deportation, held the dedication of the house of God with gladness.

17 And they offered for the dedication of the house of God a hundred calves, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs, twelve male goats for sin for all Israel, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.

18 And they stationed the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their portions for the service of God in Jerusalem, according to the writing of the book of Moses.

19 And the sons of the deportation kept the Passover on the fourteenth of the first month.

20 For the priests and the Levites were cleansed to a man, all clean, and slaughtered the Passover for all the sons of the deportation and for their brothers the priests and for themselves.

21 And the sons of Israel ate the Passover, those from the deportation and everyone separating from the uncleanness of the nations of the land to join them, to seek the Lord, the God of Israel.

22 And they kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with gladness, because the Lord gladdened them and turned the heart of the king of Assour toward them, to strengthen their hands in the works of the house of the God of Israel.

Chapter 7

1 And after these words, in the reign of Arthasastha king of the Persians, Esdras went up, son of Saraios son of Azarios son of Elkia,

2 son of Saloum son of Saddouk son of Achitob,

3 son of Samaria son of Esria son of Mareroth,

4 son of Zaraia son of Saouia son of Bokki,

5 son of Abisoue son of Phinees son of Eleazar son of Aaron the first priest;

6 this Esdras went up from Babylon, and he was a swift scribe in the law of Moses which the Lord, the God of Israel, gave; and the king gave to him, because the hand of the Lord his God was upon him, in all that he himself sought.

7 And some of the sons of Israel and some of the priests and some of the Levites, and the singers and the gatekeepers and the Nathinim, went up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of King Arthasastha.

8 And they came to Jerusalem in the fifth month; this is the king's seventh year;

9 for on the first of the first month he himself laid the foundation of the ascent from Babylon, and on the first of the fifth month they came to Jerusalem, because the hand of his God was good upon him.

10 For Esdras put it in his heart to seek the law and do it and teach ordinances and judgments in Israel.

11 And this is the transcript of the decree which Arthasastha gave to Esdras the priest, the scribe of the book of the words of the Lord's commandments and his ordinances for Israel:

12 Arthasastha king of kings to Esdras, scribe of the law of the God of heaven: The word and the answer are completed.

13 A decision was issued by me that everyone in my kingdom from the people of Israel and priests and Levites who volunteers to go to Jerusalem should go with you;

14 he was sent from before the king and the seven counselors to examine concerning Judea and Jerusalem according to the law of their God in your hand.

15 And for the house of the Lord, silver and gold which the king and the counselors voluntarily offered to the God of Israel dwelling in Jerusalem,

16 and all silver and gold, whatever you may find in all the country of Babylon, together with the voluntary offering of the people and priests voluntarily offering for the house of God in Jerusalem,

17 and everything coming in, readily enter this in this book: calves, rams, lambs and their sacrifices and their libations, and you shall offer them upon the altar of the house of your God in Jerusalem.

18 And if it seems good to you and your brothers to do anything with the remainder of the silver and gold, do as is pleasing to your God.

19 And the vessels given to you for the ministry of the house of God, hand over before God in Jerusalem.

20 And the remainder of the need of the house of your God, whatever it seems to you to give, you shall give from the king's treasury houses.

21 And from me—I, King Arthasastha, issued a decision to all the treasuries beyond the river—that everything which Esdras the priest and scribe of the law of the God of heaven asks of you should be done readily,

22 up to a hundred talents of silver and up to a hundred kors of wheat and up to a hundred baths of wine and up to a hundred baths of oil, and salt for which there is no written limit.

23 Let everything which is in the decision of the God of heaven be done. Take care lest anyone attempt anything against the house of the God of heaven, lest wrath come upon the kingdom of the king and his sons.

24 And it has been made known to you: among all the priests and Levites, singers, gatekeepers, Nathinim and ministers of this house of God, let there be no tribute for you; you shall not have authority to enslave them.

25 And you, Esdras, according to the wisdom of God in your hand, appoint scribes and judges, so that they may judge all the people beyond the river, all those knowing the law of your God, and to the one not knowing you shall make it known.

26 And everyone who does not readily do the law of God and the law of the king, judgment shall be executed upon him, whether to death or discipline or loss of possessions or bonds.

27 Blessed is the Lord, the God of our fathers, who put it thus in the king's heart to glorify the house of the Lord in Jerusalem,

28 and inclined mercy toward me in the eyes of the king and his counselors and all the king's exalted rulers. And I was strengthened, as the good hand of God was upon me, and gathered rulers from Israel to go up with me.

Chapter 8

1 And these are the rulers of their families, the guides going up with me in the reign of Arthasastha king of Babylon:

2 from the sons of Phinees, Gersom; from the sons of Ithamar, Daniel; from the sons of David, Atous;

3 from the sons of Sachania, from the sons of Phoros, Zacharias, and with him the company, a hundred fifty;

4 from the sons of Phaathmoab, Eliana son of Zaraia, and with him two hundred males;

5 from the sons of Zathoe, Sechenias son of Aziel, and with him three hundred males;

6 and from the sons of Adin, Obeth son of Jonathan, and with him fifty males;

7 and from the sons of Elam, Jesia son of Athelia, and with him seventy males;

8 and from the sons of Saphatia, Zabdia son of Michael, and with him eighty males;

9 and from the sons of Joab, Abadia son of Jiel, and with him two hundred eighteen males;

10 and from the sons of Baani, Salimouth son of Josephia, and with him a hundred sixty males;

11 and from the sons of Babi, Zacharia son of Babi, and with him seventy-eight males;

12 and from the sons of Asgad, Joanan son of Akatan, and with him a hundred ten males;

13 and from the sons of Adonikam, the last ones, and these are their names: Aliphalat, Jiel and Samaia, and with them sixty males;

14 and from the sons of Bago, Outhi, and with him seventy males.

15 And I gathered them at the river coming toward Eui, and we camped there three days. And I examined among the people and among the priests, and I found none of the sons of Levi there;

16 and I sent men to Eleazar, Ariel, Samaia and Alonam and Jarib and Elnathan and Nathan and Zacharia and Mesoulam, and discerning men to Joarib and Elnathan,

17 and brought them out before a ruler in the silver of the place and put words in their mouth to speak to their brothers, the Nathinim in the silver of the place, to bring us singers for the house of our God.

18 And there came to us, as the hand of our God was good upon us, a man sachol from the sons of Mooli son of Levi son of Israel; and at first his sons and brothers came, eighteen;

19 and Asebia and Osaia from the sons of Merari, his brothers and their sons, twenty;

20 and from the Nathinim whom David and the rulers gave for the service of the Levites, two hundred twenty Nathinim; all were gathered by names.

21 And I proclaimed a fast there at the river Aoue, to humble ourselves before our God, to seek from him a straight way for us and our children and all our possessions.

22 For I was ashamed to ask the king for a force and horsemen to save us from an enemy on the way, because we said to the king, saying, The hand of our God is upon all those seeking him for good, and his might and his wrath upon all those forsaking him.

23 And we fasted and sought from our God concerning this, and he heeded us.

24 And I set apart twelve from the rulers of the priests, for Saraia, Asabia and with them ten from their brothers,

25 and weighed out to them the silver and gold and the vessels of the first offering of the house of our God, which the king and his counselors and his rulers and all Israel who were found lifted up.

26 And I weighed out into their hands six hundred fifty talents of silver and a hundred silver vessels and a hundred talents of gold,

27 and twenty gold kaphoure for the journey, a thousand chamanim, and various vessels of good shining bronze, desirable among gold.

28 And I said to them, You are holy to the Lord, and the vessels are holy, and the silver and gold are voluntary offerings to the Lord, the God of your fathers;

29 keep awake and guard them until you stand before the rulers of the priests and the Levites and the rulers of the families in Jerusalem, in the tents of the house of the Lord.

30 And the priests and the Levites received the weight of the silver and gold and the vessels, to bring to Jerusalem, to the house of our God.

31 And we set out from the river Aoue on the twelfth of the first month to come to Jerusalem; and the hand of our God was upon us, and he delivered us from the hand of an enemy and foe on the way.

32 And we came to Jerusalem and stayed there three days.

33 And it happened on the fourth day that we weighed out the silver and gold and vessels in the house of our God into the hand of Merimoth son of Ouria the priest—and with him Eleazar son of Phinees, and with them Jozabad son of Jesus and Noadia son of Banaia, the Levites—

34 everything by number and weight, and all the weight was written. At that time,

35 those who came from the captivity, sons of the sojourning, offered whole burnt offerings to the God of Israel, twelve calves for all Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven lambs, twelve male goats for sin, all whole burnt offerings to the Lord.

36 And they gave the king's ordinance to the king's administrators and governors beyond the river, and they glorified the people and the house of God.

Chapter 9

1 And when these things were completed, the rulers approached me, saying, The people Israel and the priests and the Levites were not separated from the peoples of the lands in their abominations, the Chanani, the Ethi, the Pherezi, the Jebousi, the Ammoni, the Moabi, the Moseri and the Amori,

2 for they took from their daughters for themselves and for their sons, and the holy seed was brought among peoples of the lands, and the hand of the rulers was foremost in this faithlessness.

3 And when I heard this word, I tore my garments and was leaping, and I was plucking from the hairs of my head and from my beard, and I sat remaining still.

4 And everyone pursuing the word of the God of Israel gathered to me over the faithlessness of the exiled community, and I was sitting, remaining still until the evening sacrifice.

5 And at the evening sacrifice I arose from my humiliation; and as I tore my garments, I was leaping, and I bend upon my knees and spread out my hands toward the Lord God

6 and said, Lord, I was ashamed and abashed to lift my face toward you, for our lawless deeds multiplied above our head, and our offenses grew great as far as heaven.

7 From the days of our fathers we are in great offense until this day; and in our lawless deeds we were handed over, we and our kings and our sons, into the hand of kings of the nations, with sword and with captivity and with plunder and with shame of our face, as this day.

8 And now the Lord our God dealt leniently with us, to leave something for us for salvation and to give us a support in the place of his sanctuary, to enlighten our eyes and give a little quickening in our slavery.

9 For we are slaves, and in our slavery the Lord our God did not abandon us, and he inclined mercy upon us before kings of Persians, to give us quickening, for them to raise the house of our God and restore her desolate places, and to give us a fence in Judah and in Jerusalem.

10 What should we say, our God, after this? For we abandoned your commandments,

11 which you gave us by the hand of your slaves the prophets, saying, The land into which you enter to inherit it is a land being displaced by the displacement of peoples of the nations in their abominations, with which they filled it from mouth to mouth in their uncleannesses;

12 and now do not give your daughters to their sons, and do not take from their daughters for your sons, and you shall not seek out their peace and their good forever, so that you may grow strong and eat the good things of the land and bequeath them to your sons forever.

13 And after everything coming upon us in our evil deeds and in our great offense; for there is none like our God, for you lightened our lawless deeds and gave us salvation;

14 for we turned back to scatter your commandments and to intermarry with the peoples of the lands; do not be provoked against us to the point of consummation, so that there is no remnant and survivor.

15 Lord, God of Israel, you are righteous, for we were left surviving, as this day; behold, we are before you in our offenses, for it is not possible to stand before you on account of this.

Chapter 10

1 And as Esdras prayed and as he confessed, weeping and praying before the house of God, a very great assembly gathered to him from Israel, men and women and young men, for the people wept and raised their voice, weeping.

2 And Sechenias son of Jiiel, from the sons of Elam, answered and said to Esdras, We acted faithlessly toward our God and settled foreign wives from the peoples of the land; and now there is endurance for Israel in this.

3 And now let us make a covenant with our God to cast out all the wives and what was born from them, as you wish; arise and frighten them with the commandments of our God, and let it happen according to the law.

4 Arise, for the matter is upon you, and we are with you; be strong and act.

5 And Esdras arose and made the rulers, the priests and Levites and all Israel swear to act according to this word, and they swore.

6 And Esdras arose from before the house of God and went into the treasury of Joanan son of Elisoub, and he went there; he did not eat bread and did not drink water, for he was mourning over the faithlessness of the exiled community.

7 And they carried a proclamation through Judah and through Jerusalem to all the sons of the exiled community, to be gathered into Jerusalem,

8 and everyone who does not come within three days, according to the counsel of the rulers and the elders, all his property shall be devoted to destruction, and he shall be separated from the assembly of the exiled community.

9 And all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered into Jerusalem within the three days; this was the ninth month. On the twentieth of the month all the people sat in the square of the house of God, because of their disturbance concerning the matter and because of the storm.

10 And Esdras the priest arose and said to them, You acted faithlessly and settled foreign wives, to add to Israel's offense;

11 and now give praise to the Lord, the God of your fathers, and do what is pleasing before him, and separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from the foreign wives.

12 And the whole assembly answered and said, Great is this word of yours for us to do;

13 but the people are many, and the season is wintry, and there is no ability to stand outside; and the work is not for one day and not for two, for we multiplied wrongdoing in this matter.

14 Let our rulers, then, stand for the whole assembly, and let all those in our cities, whoever settled foreign wives, come at times by arrangements, and with them elders of each city and judges, to turn away the wrath of the anger of our God from us concerning this matter.

15 Only Jonathan son of Asael and Jazia son of Thekoue were with me concerning this, and Mesoulam and Sabbathai the Levite were helping them.

16 And the sons of the exiled community did so. And Esdras the priest and men who were rulers of ancestral families were set apart by house, and all by names, for they turned on the first day of the tenth month to investigate the matter.

17 And they finished with all the men who settled foreign wives by the first day of the first month.

18 And among the sons of the priests were found those who settled foreign wives: from the sons of Jesus son of Josedek and his brothers, Maasea and Eliezer and Jarib and Gadalia,

19 and they gave their hand to put out their wives, and a ram from the sheep as an offering for offense, concerning their offense;

20 and from the sons of Emmer, Anani and Zabdia;

21 and from the sons of Eram, Masaia and Elia and Samaia and Jiiel and Ozia;

22 and from the sons of Phasour, Elioenai, Maasaia and Ishmael and Nathanael and Jozabad and Elasa. –

23 And from the Levites: Jozabad and Samou and Kolia [he is Kolitas] and Phathaia and Jodom and Eliezer;

24 and from those singing, Elisaph; and from the gatekeepers, Sellem and Telem and Odoue. –

25 And from Israel: from the sons of Phoros, Ramia and Jazia and Melchia and Meamin and Eleazar and Asabia and Banaia;

26 and from the sons of Elam, Mathania and Zacharia and Jaiel and Abdia and Jarimoth and Elia;

27 and from the sons of Zathoua, Elioenai, Elisoub, Mathania and Jarmoth and Zabad and Oziza;

28 and from the sons of Babi, Joanan, Anania and Zabou, Othali;

29 and from the sons of Banoui, Mesoulam, Malouch, Adaias, Jasoub and Salouia and Remoth;

30 and from the sons of Phaathmoab, Edene, Chalel, Banaia, Masea, Mathania, Beselel and Banoui and Manasse;

31 and from the sons of Eram, Eliezer, Jessia, Melchia, Samaia, Semeon,

32 Benjamin, Malouch, Samaria;

33 and from the sons of Esam, Mathani, Mathatha, Zabed, Eliphaleth, Jerami, Manasse, Semei;

34 from the sons of Bani, Moodi, Amram, Ouel,

35 Banaia, Badaia, Chelia,

36 Oujechoa, Jeremoth, Eliasib,

37 Mathania, Mathanai, and they acted,

38 the sons of Banoui and the sons of Semei
39 and Selemia and Nathan and Adaia,
40 Machnadabou, Sesi, Sarou,
41 Ezerel and Selemia and Samaria
42 and Saloum, Amaria, Joseph;
43 from the sons of Nabou, Jiiel, Mathathia, Sedem, Zambina, Jadai and Joel and Banaia. –
44 All these took foreign wives and begot sons from them.

Nehemiah

Chapter 1

1 Words of Neemias son of Achalia. And it happened in the month Chaseelou, in the twentieth year, and I was in Sousan abira,

2 and Anani, one of my brothers, came, he and men of Judah, and I asked them concerning those saved, who were left from the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.

3 And they said to me, Those remaining, who were left from the captivity there in the country, are in great evil and in reproach, and the walls of Jerusalem are torn down, and her gates were burned with fire.

4 And it happened, when I heard these words, I sat and wept and mourned for days, and I was fasting and praying before the God of heaven

5 and said, Not so, Lord, God of heaven, the strong, the great and the fearsome, keeping the covenant and mercy for those loving him and those keeping his commandments;

6 let your ear, then, be attentive and your eyes opened to hear your slave's prayer, which I pray before you today, day and night, concerning the sons of Israel, your slaves, and I confess concerning the sins of the sons of Israel which we sinned against you. Both I and my father's house sinned;

7 with dissolution we acted dissolutely toward you, and we did not keep the commandments and the ordinances and the judgments which you commanded Moses your servant.

8 Remember, then, the word which you commanded Moses your servant, saying, If you act faithlessly, I will scatter you among the peoples;

9 and if you turn toward me and keep my commandments and do them, if your dispersion is from the end of heaven, from there I will gather them and bring them into the place which I chose for my name to dwell there.

10 And they are your servants and your people, whom you redeemed with your great power and with your mighty hand.

11 Not so, Lord, but let your ear be attentive to the prayer of your slave and to the prayer of your servants who wish to fear your name, and give success, then, to your servant today and give him into compassion before this man. – And I was cupbearer to the king.

Chapter 2

1 And it happened in the month Nisan, in the twentieth year for King Arthasastha, and the wine was before me, and I took the wine and gave it to the king, and there was no other before him;

2 and the king said to me, Why is your face evil, and are you not being moderate? This is nothing except evil of heart. And I feared very greatly.

3 And I said to the king, Let the king live forever; why should my face certainly not become evil, since the city, the house of my fathers' tombs, was made desolate, and her gates were consumed with fire?

4 And the king said to me, Concerning what do you seek this? And I prayed to the God of heaven

5 and said to the king, If it is good to the king, and if your servant will be favored before you, so as to send him to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, then I will rebuild it.

6 And the king and the concubine sitting beside him said to me, Until when will your journey be, and when will you return? And it was pleasing before the king, and he sent me away, and I gave him a limit.

7 And I said to the king, If it is good to the king, let him give me letters to the governors beyond the river, so as to convey me through until I come to Judah,

8 and a letter to Asaph, keeper of the garden which belongs to the king, so as to give me timber to roof the gates, and for the wall of the city, and for a house which I will enter into it. And the king gave to me according to the good hand of God.

9 And I came to the governors beyond the river and gave them the king's letters, and the king sent commanders of the force and horsemen with me. –

10 And Sanaballat the Aroni and Tobia the slave, the Ammoni, heard, and it became evil to them that a man had come to seek good for the sons of Israel.

11 And I came into Jerusalem and was there three days.

12 And I arose at night, I and a few men with me; and I did not report to a man what God puts into my heart to do with Israel, and there is no beast with me except the beast upon which I ride.

13 And I went out by the gate of the golela and toward the mouth of the spring of the figs and to the gate of the dung, and I was breaking in the wall of Jerusalem which they themselves pull down, and her gates were consumed by fire.

14 And I passed to the gate of Ain and into the king's pool, and there was no place for the beast beneath me to pass through.

15 And I was going up on the wall of the torrent at night, and I was breaking in the wall. And I was at the gate of the ravine and returned.

16 And those guarding did not know what I went for and what I do, and to the Jews and to the priests and to those honored and to the generals and to the remaining ones doing the works, until then I did not report it.

17 And I said to them, You see the evil in which we are in it, how Jerusalem is desolate and her gates were given to fire; come, and let us rebuild the wall of Jerusalem, and we will no longer be a reproach.

18 And I reported to them the hand of God, which is good upon me, and the king's words which he said to me, and I said, Let us arise and build. And their hands were strengthened for good. –

19 And Sanaballat the Aroni and Tobia the slave, the Ammoni, and Gesam the Arabi heard and laughed at us and came against us and said, What is this matter which you do? Are you rebelling against the king?

20 And I returned a word to them and said to them, The God of heaven, he himself will give us success, and we are his clean slaves, and we will build; and for you there is no portion and righteousness and memorial in Jerusalem.

Chapter 3

1 And Elisoub the great priest and his brothers the priests arose and built the sheep gate; they themselves sanctified it and set up its doors, and as far as the tower of the hundred they sanctified, as far as the tower of Ananeel,

2 and at the hands of sons of men of Jericho, and at the hands of sons of Zakchour son of Amari.

3 And the sons of Asana built the fish gate; they themselves roofed it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

4 And at their hand, from Ramoth, a son of Ouria son of Akos held firm. And at their hand Mosollam son of Barachiou son of Masezebel held firm. And at their hand Sadok son of Baana held firm.

5 And at their hand the Thekoin held firm, and adoriem did not bring their neck into their service.

6 And Joida son of Phasek and Mesoulam son of Basodia made firm the gate of Isana; they themselves roofed it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

8 And at their hand Ananias son of Rokeim made firm, and they left Jerusalem as far as the broad wall.

9 And at their hand Raphaia, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made firm.

10 And at their hand Jedaia son of Eromaph made firm, also opposite his house. And at his hand Atous son of Asbania made firm.

11 And second, Melchias son of Eram and Asoub son of Phaathmoab made firm, also as far as the tower of the thannourim.

12 And at his hand Saloum son of Alloes, ruler of half the district of Jerusalem, made firm, he and his daughters.

13 Anoun and those dwelling in Zano made firm the gate of the ravine; they themselves built it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars, and a thousand cubits in the wall as far as the gate of the dung.

14 And Melchia son of Rechab, ruler of the district of Bethacharm, made firm the gate of the dung, he and his sons, and they covered it and set up its doors and its locks and its bars.

15 And the wall of the pool of the fleeces, at the king's shearing, and as far as the stairs descending from the city of David.

16 Behind him Neemias son of Azabouch, ruler of half the district of Bethsour, made firm as far as the garden of David's tomb and as far as the pool that had been made and as far as Bethanggabarim.

17 Behind him the Levites made firm, Raoum son of Bani. At his hand Asabia, ruler of half the district of Keila, made firm for his district.

18 After him their brothers made firm, Beni son of Enadad, ruler of half the district of Keila.

19 And at his hand Azour son of Jesus, ruler of Masphe, made firm a second measure of the tower of the ascent adjoining the corner.

20 After him Barouch son of Zabou made firm a second measure, from the corner as far as the door of Bethelisoub the great priest.

21 After him Meramoth son of Ouria son of Akos made firm a second measure, from the door of Bethelisoub as far as the end of Bethelisoub.

22 And after him the priests, men of Achechar, made firm.

23 And after him Benjamin and Asoub made firm opposite their house. After him Azaria son of Maasea son of Anania made firm beside his house.

24 After him Bani son of Enadad made firm a second measure, from Bethazaria as far as the corner and as far as the bend,

25 Phalal son of Euzai opposite the corner, and the tower projecting from the king's house, the upper one belonging to the court of the guard. And after him Phadaia son of Phoros.

26 And the nathinim were dwelling in Ophal as far as the garden of the water gate eastward, and the projecting tower.

27 After him the Thekoin made firm a second measure opposite the great projecting tower and as far as the wall of Ophla.

28 Above the gate of the horses the priests made firm, each man opposite his house.

29 After him Saddouk son of Emmer made firm opposite his house. And after him Samaia son of Sechenia, keeper of the gate of the east, made firm.

30 After him Anania son of Selemia and Anoum son of Seleph, the sixth, made firm a second measure. After him Mesoulam son of Barchia made firm opposite his treasury.

31 After him Melchia son of Saraphi made firm as far as Bethanathinim, and the dealers in small wares opposite the gate of Maphekad and as far as the ascent of the bend.

32 And between the ascent of the sheep gate the smiths and the dealers in small wares made firm.

33 And it happened, when Sanaballat heard that we are building the wall, it was evil to him, and he was greatly angered and laughed at the Jews.

34 And he said before his brothers, Is this the power of Somoron, that these Jews build their own city?

35 And Tobias the Ammanite came beside him, and they said to one another, Surely they will not sacrifice or eat at their place? Will not a fox go up and pull down their wall of stones? –

36 Hear, our God, for we became an object of mockery, and turn their reproach upon their head, and give them over to mockery in a land of captivity,

37 and do not cover over lawlessness.

Chapter 4

1 And it happened, when Sanaballat and Tobia and the Arabs and the Ammanites heard that growth had risen on the walls of Jerusalem, that the breaches began to be blocked up, it appeared very evil to them;

2 and they all gathered together to come to array themselves for battle in Jerusalem.

3 And we prayed to our God and stationed advance guards against them day and night because of them.

4 And Judah said, The strength of the enemies was broken, and the loose earth is much, and we will not be able to build in the wall.

5 And those afflicting us said, They will not know and will not see until we come into their midst and murder them and stop the work.

6 And it happened, when the Jews dwelling beside them came and said to us, They are coming up against us from all the places,

7 then I stationed men in the lowest parts of the place behind the wall in the sheltered places, and I stationed the people by communities with their swords, their spears and their bows.

8 And I saw and arose and said to those honored and to the generals and to the remaining people, Do not fear before them; remember our great and fearsome God, and array yourselves for battle for your brothers, your sons and your daughters, your wives and your houses.

9 And it happened, when our enemies heard that it was known to us, and God scattered their counsel, we all returned to the wall, each man to his work.

10 And it happened, from that day half of those shaken out were doing the work, and half of them were holding out, and spears and shields and the bows and the breastplates and the rulers were behind the whole house of Judah,

11 of those building in the wall. And those lifting with the carrying apparatus were with weapons; with one hand he was doing the work itself, and one was holding the missile.

12 And the builders, each man girded with his sword upon his loin, were building, and the one sounding the horn was beside him.

13 And I said to those honored and to the rulers and to the remaining people, The work is broad and great, and we are scattered upon the wall, each man far from his brother;

14 in whatever place you hear the sound of the horn, there you shall gather to us, and our God will fight for us.

15 And we were doing the work, and half of them were holding the spears, from the rising of dawn until the coming out of the stars.

16 And at that time I said to the people, Lodge in the midst of Jerusalem, and let the night be for you an advance guard and the day work.

17 And I was there, and the men of the advance guard were behind me, and there was not a man among us taking off his garments.

Chapter 5

1 And there was a great cry of the people and their wives against their brothers the Jews.

2 And there were some saying, With our sons and with our daughters we are many; and we will take grain and eat and live.

3 And there are some saying, Our fields and our vineyards and our houses, we pledge; and we will take grain and eat.

4 And there are some saying, We borrowed silver for the king's taxes, our fields and our vineyards and our houses;

5 and now our flesh is like the flesh of our brothers, our sons like their sons; and behold, we subject our sons and our daughters to oppression as slaves, and some of our daughters are being oppressed, and there is no power in our hands, and our fields and our vineyards belong to those honored. –

6 And I was greatly grieved when I heard their cry and these words.

7 And my heart took counsel within me, and I contended with those honored and the rulers and said to them, By exaction you exact, each man from his brother. And I set a great assembly against them

8 and said to them, We have acquired our brothers the Jews who are sold to the nations, of our own free will; and do you sell your brothers? And they were silent and did not find a word.

9 And I said, The matter which you do is not good; not so, in the fear of our God you shall go away from the reproach of the nations, our enemies.

10 And my brothers and my acquaintances and I placed silver and grain among them; let us abandon this exaction, then.

11 Return to them, then, as of today, their fields, their vineyards, their olive trees and their houses; and from the silver bring out to them the grain and the wine and the oil.

12 And they said, We will give back and will not seek anything from them; thus we will do, as you say. And I called the priests and made them swear to act according to this word.

13 And I shook out my mantle and said, Thus may God shake out every man who will not establish this word, from his house and from his labor, and thus he shall be shaken out and empty. And the whole assembly said, Amen, and they praised the Lord; and the people did this thing.

14 From the day on which he commanded me to be their ruler in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year and until the thirty-second year for Arthasastha, twelve years, I and my brothers did not eat their forced levy;

15 and the former forced levies, which before me they imposed heavily upon them, and they took from them in bread and in wine, in addition silver, forty didrachms, and those of theirs shaken out exercise authority over the people, and I did not act so because of fear of God.

16 And in the work of the wall of these I did not take hold; I did not acquire a field; and all those gathered were there for the work.

17 And the Jews, a hundred and fifty men, and those coming to us from the nations around us were at my table.

18 And what was prepared for one day was one calf and six choice sheep, and a young goat was prepared for me, and at intervals of ten days, among all things, wine in abundance; and with these things I did not seek bread of the forced levy, for the service was heavy upon this people. –

19 Remember for me, God, for good, all that I did for this people.

Chapter 6

1 And it happened, when it was heard by Sanaballat and Tobia and Gesam the Arabi and the remaining ones of our enemies that I built the wall, no breath was left in them. Until that time I had not set doors in the gates.

2 And Sanaballat and Gesam sent to me, saying, Come, and let us gather together in the villages in the plain of Ono; and they were considering doing evil to me.

3 And I sent messengers to them, saying, I am doing a great work and will not be able to go down, lest the work stop; when I complete it, I will go down to you.

4 And they sent to me according to this word, and I sent to them according to these things.

5 And Sanaballat sent to me his servant, and an opened letter in his hand.

6 And it was written in it, It was heard among nations that you and the Jews consider rebelling; for this reason you build the wall, and you become their king;

7 and in addition to these things you stationed prophets for yourself, so that you may sit in Jerusalem as king in Judah; and now these words will be reported to the king; and now come, let us take counsel together.

8 And I sent to him, saying, It did not happen according to these words which you say, for from your heart you fabricate them.

9 For they all frighten us, saying, Their hands will grow slack from this work, and it will not be done; and now I strengthened my hands.

10 And I entered into the house of Semei son of Dalaia son of Meetabel – and he was confined – and he said, Let us gather into the house of God, into its midst, and close its doors, for they are coming at night to murder you.

11 And I said, Who is the man who will enter into the house and live?

12 And I recognized, and behold, God did not send him, for the prophecy was a word against me, and Tobias and Sanaballat hired

13 a crowd against me, so that I might fear and do thus and sin and become an evil name for them, so that they might reproach me. –

14 Remember, God, for Tobia and Sanaballat according to these deeds of his, and for Noadia the prophet and the remaining prophets who were frightening me.

15 And the wall was completed on the twenty-fifth of Eloul, in fifty-two days.

16 And it happened, when all our enemies heard, all the nations around us feared, and fear fell greatly in their eyes, and they knew that it came about from our God for this work to be completed. –

17 And in those days letters from many honored men of Judah were going to Tobia, and those of Tobia were coming to them,

18 for many in Judah were bound by oath to him, for he was son-in-law of Sechenia son of Erae, and Joanan his son took the daughter of Mesoulam son of Barachia as wife.

19 And they were saying his words to me and carrying out my words to him, and Tobias sent letters to frighten me.

Chapter 7

1 And it happened, when the wall was built, I set up the doors, and the gatekeepers and those singing and the Levites were appointed.

2 And I gave orders to Anania my brother and to Anania, ruler of the bira in Jerusalem, for he was like a truthful man and one fearing God beyond many,

3 and I said to them, The gates of Jerusalem shall not be opened until the sun is up, and while they are still watching, let the doors be closed and wedged shut; and station advance guards from those dwelling in Jerusalem, each man at his guard post and each man opposite his house.

4 And the city was broad and great, and the people few in it, and there were no houses built.

5 And God put it into my heart, and I gathered those honored and the rulers and the people into companies; and I found a book of the company, those who went up among the first, and I found written in it,

6 And these are sons of the country who went up from the captivity of the exiled community which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon exiled, and they returned to Jerusalem and to Judah, each man to his city,

7 with Zorobabel and Jesus and Neemias, Azaria, Daemia, Naemani, Mardochaios, Balsan, Maspharath, Esdras, Bagoi, Naoum, Baana, Masphar. Men of the people Israel:

8 sons of Phoros, two thousand one hundred and seventy-two.

9 Sons of Saphatia, three hundred and seventy-two.

10 Sons of Era, six hundred and fifty-two.

11 Sons of Phaathmoab, for the sons of Jesus and Joab, two thousand eight hundred and eighteen.

12 Sons of Ailam, one thousand two hundred and fifty-four.

13 Sons of Zathoua, eight hundred and forty-five.

14 Sons of Zakchou, seven hundred and sixty.

15 Sons of Banoui, six hundred and forty-eight.

16 Sons of Bebi, six hundred and twenty-eight.

17 Sons of Asgad, two thousand three hundred and twenty-two.

18 Sons of Adenikam, six hundred and sixty-seven.

19 Sons of Bagoi, two thousand and sixty-seven.

20 Sons of Edin, six hundred and fifty-five.

21 Sons of Ater, for Ezekia, ninety-eight.

22 Sons of Esam, three hundred and twenty-eight.

23 Sons of Besi, three hundred and twenty-four.

24 Sons of Ariph, one hundred and twelve.

25 Sons of Gabaon, ninety-five.

26 Sons of Bethlehem, one hundred and twenty-three. Sons of Netopha, fifty-six.

27 Sons of Anathoth, one hundred and twenty-eight.

28 Men of Bethasmoth, forty-two.

29 Men of Kariathiarim, Kaphira and Beroth, seven hundred and forty-three.

30 Men of Arama and Gabaa, six hundred and one.

31 Men of Machemas, one hundred and twenty-two.

32 Men of Bethel and Aia, one hundred and twenty-three.

33 Men of Nabi – aar, fifty-two.

34 Men of Elam – aar, one thousand two hundred and fifty-four.

35 Sons of Eram, three hundred and twenty.

36 Sons of Jericho, three hundred and forty-five.

37 Sons of Lod, Adid and Ono, seven hundred and twenty-one.

38 Sons of Sanaa, three thousand nine hundred and thirty. –

39 The priests: sons of Jodae, for the house of Jesus, nine hundred and seventy-three.

40 Sons of Emmer, one thousand and fifty-two.

41 Sons of Phassour, one thousand two hundred and forty-seven.

42 Sons of Eram, one thousand and seventeen. –

43 The Levites: sons of Jesus, for Kadmiel, for the sons of Oudouia, seventy-four.

44 Those singing: sons of Asaph, one hundred and forty-eight.

45 The gatekeepers: sons of Saloum, sons of Ater, sons of Telmon, sons of Akoub, sons of Atita, sons of Sabi, one hundred and thirty-eight. –

46 The nathinim: sons of Sea, sons of Asipha, sons of Tabaoth,

47 sons of Kiras, sons of Souia, sons of Phadon,

48 sons of Labana, sons of Agaba, sons of Salami,

49 sons of Anan, sons of Gadel, sons of Gaar,

50 sons of Raaia, sons of Rason, sons of Nekoda,

51 sons of Gezam, sons of Ozi, sons of Phese,

52 sons of Besi, sons of Meinom, sons of Nephosasim,

53 sons of Bakbouk, sons of Achipha, sons of Arour,

54 sons of Basaloth, sons of Meida, sons of Adasan,

55 sons of Barkous, sons of Sisara, sons of Thema,

56 sons of Nisia, sons of Atipha.

57 Sons of Solomon's slaves: sons of Souti, sons of Sapharath, sons of Pherida,

58 sons of Jeale, sons of Dorkon, sons of Gadel,

59 sons of Saphatia, sons of Etel, sons of Phacharath, sons of Sabaim, sons of Emim.

60 All the nathinim and sons of Solomon's slaves, three hundred and ninety-two. –

61 And these went up from Thelmeleth, Aresa, Charoub, Eron, Jemer, and could not report the houses of their ancestral families and their seed, whether they are from Israel:

62 sons of Dalaia, sons of Tobia, sons of Nekoda, six hundred and forty-two.

63 And from the priests: sons of Ebia, sons of Akos, sons of Berzelli, for he took wives from the daughters of Berzelli the Galaadite and was called by their name;

64 these sought their record of the company, and it was not found, and they were ἠγχιστεύθησαν [sense uncertain] from the priesthood,

65 and Athersatha said that they should not eat from the holy of holies until the priest arises to enlighten. –

66 And the whole assembly became as one, forty-two thousand three hundred and sixty,

67 besides their slaves and their female servants, these being seven thousand three hundred and thirty-seven; and male singers and female singers, two hundred and forty-five;

68 horses, seven hundred and thirty-six; mules, two hundred and forty-five;

69 camels, four hundred and thirty-five; donkeys, six thousand seven hundred and twenty. –

70 And some of the chiefs of the ancestral families gave for the work to Neemias, into the treasury, a thousand gold pieces, fifty bowls and thirty chothonoth of the priests.

71 And some of the chiefs of the ancestral families gave into the treasury of the work twenty thousand of gold and two thousand two hundred minas of silver,

72 and the remaining people gave twenty thousand of gold and two thousand two hundred minas of silver and sixty-seven chothonoth of the priests. –

73 And the priests and the Levites and the gatekeepers and those singing and those from the people and the nathinim and all Israel settled in their cities. And the seventh month arrived – and the sons of Israel were in their cities –

Chapter 8

1 and all the people gathered as one man into the broad space in front of the water gate. And they told Esdras the scribe to bring the book of the law of Moses, which the Lord commanded Israel.

2 And Esdras the priest brought the law before the assembly, from man to woman, and everyone understanding to hear, on the first day of the seventh month,

3 and he read in it from the hour when the sun shines through until the middle of the day, before the men and the women, and they were understanding, and the ears of all the people were toward the book of the law.

4 And Esdras the scribe stood upon a wooden platform, and beside him stood Mattathias and Samaias and Ananias and Ouria and Elkia and Maasaia on his right, and on the left Phadaias and Misael and Melchias and Osam and Asabdana and Zacharias and Mosollam.

5 And Esdras opened the book before all the people – for he was above the people – and it happened, when he opened it, all the people stood.

6 And Esdras blessed the Lord, the great God, and all the people answered and said, Amen, lifting their hands, and they bent down and worshiped the Lord upon their face on the earth.

7 And Jesus and Banaias and Sarabia were instructing the people in the law, and the people were at their station.

8 And they read in the book of the law of God, and Esdras taught and explained distinctly in knowledge of the Lord, and the people understood in the reading. –

9 And Neemias and Esdras the priest and scribe and the Levites instructing the people spoke and said to all the people, The day is holy to the Lord our God; do not mourn or weep; for all the people were weeping when they heard the words of the law.

10 And he said to them, Go, eat rich foods and drink sweet drinks and send portions to those who do not have, for the day is holy to our Lord; and do not fall apart, for it is your strength.

11 And the Levites were quieting all the people, saying, Be silent, for the day is holy, and do not fall down.

12 And all the people went away to eat and drink and send portions and make great rejoicing, for they understood the words which he made known to them.

13 And on the second day the rulers of the ancestral families for all the people, the priests and the Levites, gathered to Esdras the scribe to attend to all the words of the law.

14 And they found written in the law which the Lord commanded Moses, that the sons of Israel should dwell in tents during a feast in the seventh month,

15 and that they should signal with trumpets in all their cities and in Jerusalem. And Esdras said, Go out to the mountain and bring olive leaves and leaves of cypress trees and myrtle leaves and palm leaves and leaves of a dense tree, to make tents according to what is written.

16 And the people went out and brought them and made tents for themselves, each man upon his roof, and in their courts and in the courts of the house of God and in the squares of the city and as far as the gate of Ephraim.

17 And the whole assembly, those returning from the captivity, made tents and settled in tents; for from the days of Jesus son of Naue the sons of Israel had not done so until that day; and there was great rejoicing.

18 And he read in the book of the law of God day by day, from the first day until the last day; and they held a feast for seven days, and on the eighth day a closing observance according to the judgment.

Chapter 9

1 And on the twenty-fourth day of this month the sons of Israel gathered in fasting and in sackcloth.

2 And the sons of Israel separated themselves from every foreign son and stood and confessed their sins and the lawless deeds of their fathers.

3 And they stood at their station and read in the book of the law of the Lord their God, and they were confessing to the Lord and worshiping the Lord their God.

4 And on the ascent of the Levites stood Jesus and sons of Kadmiel, Sachania son of Sarabia, sons of Chanani, and they cried with a great voice to the Lord their God.

5 And the Levites Jesus and Kadmiel said, Arise, bless the Lord your God from age to age, and they will bless the name of your glory and exalt it above every blessing and praise.

6 And Esdras said, You yourself alone are Lord; you made heaven and the heaven of heaven and all their array, the earth and all that is in it, the seas and all that is in them, and you give life to all things, and the armies of the heavens worship you.

7 You are the Lord God; you made your choice in Abram and brought him out of the country of the Chaldeans and placed upon him the name Abraham;

8 and you found his heart faithful before you and made a covenant with him to give him the land of the Chananites and Chettites and Amorrites and Pherezites and Jebousites and Gergesites, and to his seed; and you established your words, for you are righteous.

9 And you saw the humiliation of our fathers in Egypt and heard their cry at the Red Sea.

10 And you gave signs in Egypt, in Pharaoh and in all his servants and in all the people of his land, for you knew that they acted arrogantly against them, and you made a name for yourself, as this day.

11 And you broke open the sea before them, and they passed through the midst of the sea on dry ground, and those pursuing them you threw into the deep like a stone in mighty water.

12 And in a pillar of cloud you guided them by day, and in a pillar of fire by night, to light for them the way in which they will travel.

13 And you descended upon Mount Sina and spoke to them from heaven and gave them upright judgments and laws of truth, good ordinances and commandments.

14 And you made known to them your holy sabbath; commandments and ordinances and law you commanded them by the hand of Moses your slave.

15 And you gave them bread from heaven for their lack of grain and brought out water from rock for them for their thirst. And you told them to enter to inherit the land concerning which you stretched out your hand to give it to them.

16 And they and our fathers acted arrogantly and hardened their neck and did not hear your commandments;

17 and they refused to listen and did not remember your wonders which you did with them, and they hardened their neck and gave a beginning to return to their slavery in Egypt. And you are a merciful and compassionate God, long-suffering and abundant in mercy, and you did not abandon them.

18 And moreover they also made themselves a cast calf and said, These are the gods who brought us out of Egypt; and they made great provocations to anger.

19 And you in your many compassions did not abandon them in the wilderness; you did not turn away from them the pillar of cloud by day to guide them in the way, and the pillar of fire by night to light for them the way in which they will travel.

20 And you gave your good spirit to instruct them, and you did not withhold your manna from their mouth, and you gave them water for their thirst.

21 And forty years you nourished them in the wilderness; they did not lack; their garments did not grow old, and their feet did not split open.

22 And you gave them kingdoms and peoples and divided them for them, and they inherited the land of Seon king of Esebon and the land of Og king of Basan.

23 And you multiplied their sons like the stars of heaven and brought them into the land which you spoke of to their fathers, and they inherited it.

24 And you wiped out before them those dwelling in the land of the Chananites and gave them into their hands, and their kings and the peoples of the land, to do to them as was pleasing before them.

25 And they seized high cities and inherited houses full of all good things, hewn pits, vineyards and olive groves and every tree for food in abundance; and they ate and were filled and grew fat and lived luxuriously in your great goodness.

26 And they changed and departed from you and threw your law behind their body and killed your prophets, who testified among them to turn them toward you, and they made great provocations to anger.

27 And you gave them into the hand of those afflicting them, and they afflicted them; and they cried out to you at the time of their affliction, and you heard from your heaven and in your great compassions gave them saviors and saved them from the hand of those afflicting them.

28 And when they rested, they turned back to do evil before you; and you abandoned them into the hands of their enemies, and they ruled over them. And again they cried out to you, and you listened from heaven and rescued them in your many compassions.

29 And you testified to them to turn them to your law, and they did not hear, but in your commandments and in your judgments they sinned, which, if a man does them, he will live in them; and they gave a disobedient back and hardened their neck and did not hear.

30 And you prolonged matters over them for many years and testified to them by your spirit through the hand of your prophets; and they did not give ear, and you gave them into the hand of peoples of the land.

31 And you in your many compassions did not make an end of them and did not abandon them, for you are strong and merciful and compassionate.

32 And now, our God, the strong, the great, the mighty and the fearsome, keeping your covenant and your mercy, let not all the hardship be made little before you which found us and our kings and our rulers and our priests and our prophets and our fathers, and among all your people, from the days of kings of Assour and until this day.

33 And you are righteous in all things coming upon us, for you acted in truth, and we sinned.

34 And our kings and our rulers and our priests and our fathers did not do your law and did not attend to your commandments and your testimonies which you testified to them.

35 And they in your kingdom and in your abundant goodness which you gave them, and in the broad and rich land which you gave before them, did not serve you and did not turn away from their evil practices.

36 Behold, today we are slaves, and the land which you gave our fathers to eat its fruit,

37 is for the kings whom you gave over us in our sins, and they exercise authority over our bodies and over our beasts as is pleasing to them, and we are in great affliction.

Chapter 10

1 And in all these things we make a pledge of faithfulness and write, and all our rulers, our Levites, our priests affix seals.

2 And among those sealing were Neemias son of Achalia and Sedekias

3 son of Saraia, and Azaria and Jermia,

4 Phasour, Amaria, Melchia,

5 Atous, Sebani, Malouch,

6 Iram, Meramoth, Abdia,

7 Daniel, Ganathon, Barouch,

8 Mesoulam, Abia, Miamin,

9 Maazia, Belgai, Samaia; these were priests;

10 and the Levites, Jesus son of Azania, Banaiou from the sons of Enadad, Kadmiel

11 and his brothers, Sabania, Odouia, Kalita, Pheleia, Anan,

12 Micha, Roob, Esebias,

13 Zachor, Sarabia, Sebania,

14 Odouia, sons of Banounai;

15 rulers of the people, Phoros, Phaathmoab, Elam, Zathouia, sons of

16 Bani, Asgad, Bebai,

17 Edania, Bagoi, Edin,

18 Ater, Ezekia, Azour,

19 Odouia, Esam, Besi,

20 Ariph, Anathoth, Nobai,

21 Magaphes, Mesoulam, Ezir,

22 Mesozebel, Saddouk, Jeddoua,

23 Phaltia, Anan, Anaia,

24 Osee, Anania, Asoub,

25 Aloes, Phalai, Sobek,

26 Raoum, Esabana, Maasaia

27 and Aia, Ainan, Enan,

28 Malouch, Eram, Baana.

29 And the remaining people, the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, those singing, the nathinim and everyone coming from peoples of the land toward the law of God, their wives, their sons, their daughters, everyone knowing and understanding,

30 were strengthening themselves against their brothers, cursed them and entered into a curse and into an oath to walk in the law of God which was given by the hand of Moses the slave of God, and to keep and do all the commandments of our Lord and his judgments,

31 and not to give our daughters to the peoples of the land, and we will not take their daughters for our sons.

32 And the peoples of the land who bring merchandise and every article for sale on the sabbath day to sell, we do not buy from them on the sabbath and on a holy day. And we will release the seventh year and the exaction of every hand.

33 And we will establish commandments upon ourselves, to impose upon ourselves the giving of a third of the didrachm each year for the service of the house of our God,

34 for bread of the presence and the continual sacrifice and for the continual whole burnt offering of the sabbaths, of the new moons, for the feasts and for the holy things, and the offerings for sin to make atonement for Israel, and for works of the house of our God.

35 And we cast lots concerning the lot of wood-bearing, the priests and the Levites and the people, to bring it into the house of our God, by house of our ancestral families, at appointed times, year by year, to burn upon the altar of the Lord our God, as it is written in the law,

36 and to bring the first produce of our land and the first produce of the fruit of every tree, year by year, into the house of the Lord,

37 and the firstborn of our sons and of our beasts, as it is written in the law, and the firstborn of our cattle and our flocks, to bring into the house of our God to the priests ministering in the house of our God.

38 And the first portion of our grain and the fruit of every tree, of wine and of oil, we will bring to the priests into the treasury of the house of God; and a tenth of our land to the Levites. And the Levites themselves collect tithes in all the cities of our service,

39 and the priest, a son of Aaron, shall be with the Levite at the Levite's tithe, and the Levites will bring up the tenth of the tenth into the house of our God, into the treasuries, into the house of God.

40 For into the treasuries the sons of Israel and the sons of Levi will bring the first portions of grain and of wine and of oil, and there are the holy vessels and the priests who minister and the gatekeepers and those singing. And we will not abandon the house of our God.

Chapter 11

1 And the rulers of the people settled in Jerusalem, and the remaining people cast lots to bring one out of ten to settle in Jerusalem, the holy city, and nine portions in the cities.

2 And the people blessed all the men volunteering to settle in Jerusalem.

3 And these are the rulers of the country who settled in Jerusalem; and in the cities of Judah they settled, each man in his possession in their cities, Israel, the priests and the Levites and the nathinaians and the sons of Solomon's slaves;

4 and in Jerusalem some of the sons of Judah and some of the sons of Benjamin settled. – From the sons of Judah: Athaia son of Azaia son of Zacharia son of Amaria son of Saphatia son of Malelel, and from the sons of Phares.

5 And Maasia son of Barouch son of Chalaza son of Ozia son of Adaia son of Jorib son of Thezia son of the Seloni.

6 All the sons of Phares dwelling in Jerusalem, four hundred and sixty-eight men of strength. –

7 And these are sons of Benjamin: Selo son of Mesoulam son of Joad son of Phadaia son of Kolia son of Masaia son of Aithiel son of Jesia;

8 and behind him Gebi, Seli, nine hundred and twenty-eight.

9 And Joel son of Zechri was overseer over them, and Judas son of Asana was second over the city. –

10 From the priests: also Jadia son of Jorib, Jachin,

11 Saraia son of Elkia son of Mesoulam son of Saddouk son of Marioth son of Aitob, opposite the house of God.

12 And their brothers doing the work of the house: Amasi son of Zacharia son of Phassour son of Melchia,

13 rulers of ancestral families, two hundred and forty-two. And Amessai son of Esdriel,

14 and his brothers, mighty in battle array, one hundred and twenty-eight, and overseer over them, Badiel. –

15 And from the Levites, Samaia son of Asoub son of Ezri

17 and Mathania son of Micha and Obed son of Samoui,

18 two hundred and eighty-four.

19 And the gatekeepers Akoub, Telamin, and their brothers, one hundred and seventy-two.

22 And an overseer of Levites was a son of Bani, Ozi son of Asabia son of Micha. From the sons of Asaph, those singing opposite the work of the house of God;

23 for the king's commandment was upon them.

24 And Pathaia son of Baseza was at the king's hand for every matter concerning the people. –

25 And toward the settlements in their field. And some of the sons of Judah settled in Kariatharbok

26 and in Jesou

27 and in Beersabee,

30 and their settlements, Lachis and her fields; and they encamped in Beersabee.

31 And the sons of Benjamin were from Gaba, Machamas.

36 And from the Levites, portions of Judah for Benjamin.

Chapter 12

1 And these are the priests and the Levites going up with Zorobabel son of Salathiel and Jesus: Saraia, Jermia, Esdras,

2 Amaria, Malouch,

3 Sechenia;

7 these were rulers of the priests and their brothers in the days of Jesus. –

8 And the Levites: Jesou, Banoui, Kadmiel, Sarabia, Judah, Machania; over the hands, he and his brothers,

9 for the daily divisions.

10 And Jesus begot Joakim, and Joakim begot Eliasib, and Eliasib, Jodae,

11 and Jodae begot Jonathan, and Jonathan begot Jadou.

12 And in the days of Joakim, his brothers the priests and the rulers of the ancestral families: for Saraia, Maraia; for Jermia, Anania;

13 for Esdras, Mesoulam; for Amaria, Joanan;

14 for Malouch, Jonathan; for Sechenia, Joseph;

15 for Arem, Adnas; for Marioth, Elkai;

16 for Addai, Zacharias; for Ganathon, Mosollam;

17 for Abia, Zechri; for Benjamin, at times, for Pheleti;

18 for Balga, Samoue; for Semeia, Jonathan;

19 for Joiarib, Maththanai; for Idia, Ozi;

20 for Sallai, Kallai; for Amouk, Abed;

21 for Elkia, Asabias; for Jedeiou, Nathanael. –

22 The Levites in the days of Eliasib, Joada and Joanan and Idoua were recorded as rulers of ancestral families, and the priests in the reign of Darius the Persian;

23 sons of Levi, rulers of the ancestral families, recorded in the book of words of the days, even until the days of Joanan son of Elisoub.

24 And rulers of the Levites: Asabia and Sarabia and Jesou and sons of Kadmiel and their brothers opposite them, to sing hymns and praise by the commandment of David the man of God, daily division against daily division,

25 when I gathered the gatekeepers,

26 in the days of Joakim son of Jesus son of Josedek and in the days of Neemias, and Esdras the priest, the scribe.

27 And at the dedication of the wall of Jerusalem they sought the Levites in their places to bring them into Jerusalem to make a dedication and rejoicing with thodatha and with songs, sounding cymbals, and psalteries and lyres.

28 And the sons of those singing gathered, also from the surrounding district round about into Jerusalem, and from settlements

29 and from fields; for those singing built settlements for themselves in Jerusalem.

30 And the priests and the Levites were cleansed, and they cleansed the people and the gatekeepers and the wall.

31 And I brought up the rulers of Judah upon the wall and stationed two great ones for praise, and they passed on the right upon the wall of the dung,

32 and Osaia and half the rulers of Judah went behind them,

33 and Azarias, Esdras and Mesoulam,

34 Judah and Benjamin and Samaia and Jermia,

35 and from the sons of the priests, with trumpets, Zacharias son of Jonathan son of Samaia son of Mathania son of Michaia son of Zakchour son of Asaph,

36 and his brothers Samaia and Oziel, to praise with songs of David the man of God, and Esdras the scribe in front of them;

37 at the gate of ain opposite them they went up upon the stairs of the city of David, at the ascent of the wall above the house of David and as far as the water gate eastward. –

38 And the second one for praise was going to meet them, and I behind it, and half the people upon the wall above the tower of the thennourim and as far as the broad wall,

39 and above the gate of Ephraim and to the gate of isana and to the fish gate and at the tower of Ananeel and as far as the sheep gate, and they stood at the gate of the guard.

40 And the two of praise stood in the house of God, and I and half the generals with me,

41 and the priests Eliakim, Maasias, Benjamin, Michaias, Elioenai, Zacharias, Ananias, with trumpets,

42 and Maasias and Semeias and Eleazar and Ozi and Joanan and Melchias and Ailam and Ezour, and those singing were heard and were appointed.

43 And on that day they sacrificed great sacrifices and rejoiced, for God made them rejoice greatly; and their wives and their children rejoiced, and the rejoicing in Jerusalem was heard from far away.

44 And on that day they appointed men over the treasuries for the stores, the first portions and the tithes, and for the rulers of the cities gathered in them, portions for the priests and for the Levites, for there was rejoicing in Judah over the priests and over the Levites standing there.

45 And they kept the watches of their God and the watches of purification, and those singing and the gatekeepers, according to the commandments of David and Solomon his son;

46 for in the days of David, Asaph from the beginning was first of those singing, and a hymn and praise to God,

47 and all Israel in the days of Zorobabel were giving portions of those singing and of the gatekeepers, a day's matter on its day, and consecrating for the Levites, and the Levites consecrating for the sons of Aaron.

Chapter 13

1 On that day it was read in the book of Moses in the ears of the people, and it was found written in it that Ammanites and Moabites should not enter into the assembly of God forever,

2 for they did not meet the sons of Israel with bread and with water, and they hired Balaam against him to curse, and our God turned the curse into a blessing.

3 And it happened, when they heard the law, every mixed person in Israel was separated.

4 And before this Eliasib the priest, dwelling in a treasury of the house of our God, being near Tobia,

5 made him a great treasury, and there they had formerly been putting the manaan and the frankincense and the vessels and the tenth of grain and of wine and of oil, the commandment of the Levites and of those singing and of the gatekeepers, and first portions of the priests.

6 And during all this I was not in Jerusalem, for in the thirty-second year of Arthasastha king of Babylon I came to the king. And after the end of days I made a request of the king

7 and came into Jerusalem. And I understood the evil which Elisoub did for Tobia, to make him a treasury in the court of the house of God.

8 And it appeared very evil to me, and I threw all the vessels of Tobia's house outside, out of the treasury;

9 and I spoke, and they cleansed the treasuries, and I returned there the vessels of the house of God, the manaa and the frankincense.

10 And I knew that the portions of the Levites had not been given, and the Levites and those singing who were doing the work fled, each man to his field.

11 And I contended with the generals and said, Why was the house of God abandoned? And I gathered them and stationed them at their station.

12 And all Judah brought a tenth of the wheat and of the wine and of the oil into the stores,

13 at the hand of Selemia the priest and Saddouk the scribe and Phadaia from the Levites, and at their hand Anan son of Zakchour son of Mathania, for they were reckoned faithful, to distribute to their brothers.

14 Remember me, God, in this, and let not my mercy be wiped out, which I did in the house of the Lord God.

15 In those days I saw in Judah people treading winepresses on the sabbath and bringing sheaves and loading them upon the donkeys, and wine and grapes and figs and every burden, and bringing them into Jerusalem on the sabbath day; and I testified on the day of their selling.

16 And they settled in it, bringing fish and every article for sale, selling on the sabbath to the sons of Judah and in Jerusalem.

17 And I contended with the free sons of Judah and said to them, What is this evil matter which you do and profane the sabbath day?

18 Did not your fathers act so? And our God brought all these evils upon them and upon us and upon this city; and you add wrath upon Israel by profaning the sabbath.

19 And it happened, when the gates of Jerusalem were set in place before the sabbath, I spoke and they closed the gates, and I said that they should not be opened until after the sabbath; and some of my young servants I stationed at the gates so that burdens should not be lifted on the sabbath day.

20 And they all lodged and carried on selling outside Jerusalem once and twice.

21 And I testified among them and said to them, Why do you lodge opposite the wall? If you do it a second time, I will stretch out my hand against you. From that time they did not come on the sabbath.

22 And I told the Levites, who were cleansing themselves and coming to guard the gates, to sanctify the sabbath day. For these things remember me, God, and spare me according to the abundance of your mercy.

23 And in those days I saw the Jews who settled Azotian, Ammanite, Moabite wives,

24 and their sons, half speaking Azotian, and they do not know how to speak Judean,

25 and I contended with them and cursed them and struck men among them and pulled out their hair and made them swear by God, If you give your daughters to their sons, and if you take from their daughters for your sons.

26 Did not Solomon king of Israel sin so? And among many nations there was no king like him; and he was loved by God, and God made him king over all Israel. And the foreign wives turned even this man aside.

27 And shall we not hear of you doing all this evil, acting faithlessly toward our God, settling foreign wives? –

28 And from the sons of Joada, of Elisoub the great priest, son-in-law of Sanaballat the Oronite, and I drove him out from me.

29 Remember for them, God, concerning the kinship of the priesthood and the covenant of the priesthood, and the Levites. –

30 And I cleansed them from every foreign association and stationed daily divisions for the priests and for the Levites, each man according to his work,

31 and the gift of the wood-bearers at appointed times and among the bakchouria. Remember me, our God, for goodness.

Esther

Chapter 1

1 a In the second year of the reign of Artaxerxes the great, on the first of Nisa, Mardochaios son of Jairos son of Semeios son of Kisaios, from the tribe of Benjamin, saw a dream,

2 a Jewish man dwelling in the city of Sousoi, a great man serving in the king's court;

3 and he was from the captivity which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon took captive from Jerusalem with Jechonias king of Judea.

4 And this was his dream: and behold, voices and uproar, thunders and an earthquake, tumult upon the earth;

5 and behold, two great dragons came forward, both ready to wrestle, and their voice became great;

6 and at their voice every nation prepared for war, so as to wage war against a nation of righteous people.

7 And behold, a day of darkness and gloom, affliction and distress, maltreatment and great tumult upon the earth;

8 and the whole righteous nation was troubled, fearing their own evils, and they prepared to perish and cried to God.

9 And from their cry there came, as though from a small spring, a great river, much water;

1 k light and the sun rose, and the humble were exalted and devoured the glorious. –

2 And Mardochaios, having awakened, who had seen this dream and what God has resolved to do, held it in his heart and in every matter wished to understand it until night.

3 And Mardochaios rested in the court with Gabatha and Tharra, the king's two eunuchs guarding the court,

4 and he heard their reasonings and investigated their concerns and learned that they are preparing to lay hands upon King Artaxerxes, and he informed the king concerning them;

5 and the king examined the two eunuchs, and after confessing they were led away.

6 And the king wrote these matters as a memorial, and Mardochaios wrote concerning these matters;

7 and the king commanded Mardochaios to serve in the court and gave him gifts for these things.

8 And Aman son of Amadathos, a Bougaian, was glorious before the king; and he sought to do evil to Mardochaios and his people on behalf of the king's two eunuchs.

9 And it happened after these matters in the days of Artaxerxes – this Artaxerxes held sway over a hundred and twenty-seven territories from India –

2 in those very days, when King Artaxerxes was enthroned in the city of Sousoi,

3 in the third year of his reign he made a reception for his friends and the remaining nations and the glorious men of Persians and Medes and the rulers of the satraps.

4 And after these things, after showing them the wealth of his kingdom and the glory of the rejoicing of his wealth for a hundred and eighty days,

5 when the days of the wedding were fulfilled, the king made a drinking feast for the nations found in the city for six days, in the court of the king's house,

6 adorned with fine linen and cotton hangings stretched on fine linen and purple cords on gold and silver cubes upon pillars of Parian stone and stone; gold and silver couches upon a pavement of emerald stone and mother-of-pearl and Parian stone, and translucent coverings variously adorned with flowers, roses sprinkled round about;

7 gold and silver drinking cups and a little carbuncle cup set out, of thirty thousand talents; much sweet wine, which the king himself drank.

8 And this drinking feast did not take place according to an established law, but the king wished so and commanded the stewards to do his will and that of the people.

9 And Astin the queen made a drinking feast for the women in the royal quarters where King Artaxerxes was.

10 And on the seventh day the king, having become merry, told Aman and Bazan and Tharra and Boraze and Zatholtha and Abataza and Tharaba, the seven eunuchs who served King Artaxerxes,

11 to bring the queen in to him, for her to reign, and to place the diadem upon her and to show her to all the rulers and the nations, her beauty, for she was beautiful.

12 And Astin the queen did not heed him, to come with the eunuchs. And the king was grieved and angered

13 and said to his friends, Astin spoke according to these things; make, then, a law and judgment concerning this.

14 And Arkesaios and Sarsathaios and Malesear, the rulers of Persians and Medes, those near the king, those sitting first beside the king, approached him

15 and reported to him according to the laws how one must deal with Astin the queen, for she did not do what was commanded by the king through the eunuchs.

16 And Mouchaios said to the king and the rulers, Astin the queen wronged not the king alone, but also all the rulers and the king's leaders,

17 [for he also related to them the queen's words and how she contradicted the king]. As, then, she contradicted King Artaxerxes,

18 so today the remaining ruling women of the rulers of Persians and Medes, having heard what was said by her to the king, will likewise dare to dishonor their husbands.

19 If, then, it seems good to the king, let him command a royal decree, and let it be written according to the laws of Medes and Persians; and let him not act otherwise, nor let the queen enter to him any longer, and let the king give her queenship to a woman better than she.

20 And let the law from the king, whatever he makes, be heard in his kingdom, and thus all the women will confer honor upon their own husbands, from poor to rich.

21 And the word pleased the king and the rulers, and the king did as Mouchaios spoke;

22 and he sent into the whole kingdom, territory by territory, according to their language, so that there should be fear for them in their houses.

Chapter 2

1 And after these matters the king ceased from his anger and no longer remembered Astin, remembering what she spoke and how he condemned her.

2 And the king's servants said, Let uncorrupted girls, beautiful in appearance, be sought for the king;

3 and the king will appoint village rulers in all the territories of his kingdom, and let them select virgin girls, beautiful in appearance, into the city of Sousan, into the women's quarters, and let them be handed over to the king's eunuch, the keeper of the women, and let cleansing ointment and the remaining care be given;

4 and the woman who pleases the king will reign instead of Astin. And the matter pleased the king, and he did so.

5 And there was a Jewish man in the city of Sousoi, and his name was Mardochaios son of Jairos son of Semeios son of Kisaios, from the tribe of Benjamin,

6 who was a captive from Jerusalem, which Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon took captive.

7 And he had a foster child, a daughter of Aminadab, his father's brother, and her name was Esther; and when her parents died, he brought her up for himself as a wife; and the girl was beautiful in appearance.

8 And when the king's ordinance was heard, many girls gathered into the city of Sousan under the hand of Gai, and Esther was brought to Gai, the keeper of the women.

9 And the girl pleased him and found favor before him, and he hurried to give her the cleansing ointment and the portion and the seven girls assigned to her from the royal household, and he treated her and her maids well in the women's quarters;

10 and Esther did not reveal her race or her homeland, for Mardochaios commanded her not to report them.

11 And each day Mardochaios walked about the women's court, watching what would happen to Esther.

12 And this was the time for a girl to enter to the king, when she completes twelve months; for thus the days of care are completed, six months being anointed with myrrh oil and six months with aromatics and with the women's cleansing ointments,

13 and then she enters to the king; and whatever she asks for, he will hand over to her to go in with her from the women's quarters to the royal quarters.

14 At evening she enters, and toward day she runs back into the second women's quarters, where Gai, the king's eunuch, the keeper of the women, is, and she no longer enters to the king unless called by name.

15 And when the time was fulfilled for Esther, daughter of Aminadab, the brother of Mardochaios's father, to enter to the king, she rejected none of what the eunuch, the keeper of the women, commanded her; for Esther was finding favor with all those seeing her.

16 And Esther entered to King Artaxerxes in the twelfth month, which is Adar, in the seventh year of his reign.

17 And the king fell in love with Esther, and she found favor beyond all the virgins, and he placed the women's diadem upon her.

18 And the king made a drinking feast for all his friends and the forces for seven days and exalted Esther's wedding and made a remission for those under his reign.

19 And Mardochaios was serving in the court.

20 And Esther did not reveal her homeland; for thus Mardochaios commanded her, to fear God and do his ordinances, as when she was with him, and Esther did not change her conduct.

21 And the king's two eunuchs, the chief bodyguards, were grieved because Mardochaios was promoted, and they sought to kill King Artaxerxes.

22 And the matter was made known to Mardochaios, and he informed Esther, and she disclosed the matters of the plot to the king.

23 And the king examined the two eunuchs and hanged them; and the king commanded it to be recorded as a memorial in the royal library, concerning Mardochaios's goodwill, in a commendation.

Chapter 3

1 And after these things King Artaxerxes glorified Aman son of Amadathos, the Bougaian, and exalted him, and he held the first rank among all his friends.

2 And all those in the court bowed down to him, for thus the king commanded them to do; but Mardochaios did not bow down to him.

3 And those in the king's court said to Mardochaios, Mardochaios, why do you disobey what is said by the king?

4 Each day they spoke to him, and he did not heed them; and they informed Aman that Mardochaios opposed the king's words; and Mardochaios informed them that he is Jewish.

5 And Aman, recognizing that Mardochaios does not bow down to him, became very angry

6 and resolved to destroy all the Jews under the reign of Artaxerxes.

7 And he made a decree in the twelfth year of the reign of Artaxerxes and cast lots, day by day and month by month, so as to destroy the race of Mardochaios in one day, and the lot fell on the fourteenth of the month which is Adar.

8 And he spoke to King Artaxerxes, saying, There exists a nation dispersed among the nations in all your kingdom, and their laws are different beyond all the nations, and they disobey the king's laws, and it does not benefit the king to leave them;

9 if it seems good to the king, let him decree to destroy them, and I will pay into the king's treasury ten thousand talents of silver.

10 And the king, taking off his ring, gave it into Aman's hand to seal in accordance with what was written against the Jews.

11 And the king said to Aman, Keep the silver, and deal with the nation as you wish.

12 And the king's scribes were called in the first month on the thirteenth, and they wrote, as Aman commanded, to the generals and the rulers in every territory from India to Ethiopia, to the hundred and twenty-seven territories, and to the rulers of the nations according to their own language, by King Artaxerxes.

13 And it was sent by letter-bearers into the kingdom of Artaxerxes, to destroy the race of the Jews on one day of the twelfth month, which is Adar, and to plunder their possessions. –

13 a And this is the copy of the letter: The great King Artaxerxes writes these things to the rulers of the hundred and twenty-seven territories from India to Ethiopia and the local rulers subject to them:

14 Having ruled many nations and prevailed over the whole inhabited world, I wished, without being lifted up by the audacity of authority, but always conducting affairs more reasonably and with gentleness, to establish the lives of those subject to me as ever untroubled by waves, providing the kingdom as peaceful and traversable to its limits, and to renew the peace desired by all people.

15 And when I inquired of the counselors how this might be brought to completion, Aman, who excelled in prudence among us and was proven in unchanging goodwill and firm faithfulness and had carried off the second honor of the kingdoms,

16 showed us that among all the tribes throughout the inhabited world a certain hostile people has been mixed in, opposed in its laws to every nation, continually disregarding the ordinances of the kings, so as not to accept the joint government directed blamelessly by us.

17 Having therefore determined that this nation alone stands continually in opposition to every person, varying in a strange course of laws and ill-disposed toward our affairs, accomplishing the worst evils, even so that the kingdom should not obtain stability;

18 we have therefore commanded that all those indicated to you in what is written by Aman, appointed over affairs and our second father, together with wives and children, be destroyed root and all by the swords of the enemies, without any pity and sparing, on the fourteenth of the twelfth month Adar of the present year,

19 so that those hostile of old and now, having descended violently into Hades in one day, may provide our affairs as stable and untroubled for all subsequent time. –

14 And the copies of the letters were posted territory by territory, and all the nations were commanded to be ready for this day.

15 And the matter was hastened also into Sousan; and the king and Aman were drinking deeply, but the city was troubled.

Chapter 4

1 But Mardochaios, learning what was being accomplished, tore his garments and put on sackcloth and sprinkled himself with ashes, and rushing out through the city's square, cried with a loud voice, A nation that has done no wrong is being taken away.

2 And he came as far as the king's gate and stood; for he was not permitted to enter the court wearing sackcloth and ashes.

3 And in every region where the letters were posted, there was an outcry and beating of the breast and great mourning for the Jews; they spread sackcloth and ashes for themselves.

4 And the queen's maids and eunuchs came in and reported to her, and she was troubled on hearing what had happened, and sent to clothe Mardochaios and remove his sackcloth, but he was not persuaded.

5 But Esther summoned Achrathaios, her eunuch, who attended her, and sent him to learn for her the exact matter from Mardochaios;

7 and Mardochaios explained to him what had happened and the promise that Aman had promised the king, of ten thousand talents for the treasury, so that he might destroy the Jews;

8 and he gave him the copy posted in Sousa for their destruction, to show Esther, and told him to instruct her to go in and entreat the king and petition him concerning the people: remembering the days of your humiliation, how you were reared in my hand, because Aman, who is second to the king, has spoken against us for death; call upon the Lord and speak to the king concerning us and rescue us from death.

9 And Achrathaios went in and spoke all these words to her.

10 And Esther said to Achrathaios, Go to Mardochaios and say that

11 All the nations of the kingdom know that every man or woman who enters to the king into the inner court uncalled has no deliverance; except that the one to whom the king extends the golden rod will be delivered; and I have not been called to enter to the king these thirty days.

12 And Achrathaios reported all Esther's words to Mardochaios.

13 And Mardochaios said to Achrathaios, Go and say to her, Esther, do not say to yourself that you alone in the kingdom will be delivered above all the Jews;

14 because if you refuse to listen at this time, help and shelter will come to the Jews from elsewhere, but you and your father's house will perish; and who knows whether you became queen for this time?

15 And Esther sent the one who had come to her away to Mardochaios, saying,

16 Go and assemble the Jews in Sousa, and fast for me, and neither eat nor drink for three days, night and day; and I and my maids will go without food, and then I will enter to the king contrary to the law, even if I must perish.

17 And Mardochaios went and did all that Esther had commanded him,

17 a and petitioned the Lord, remembering all the Lord's works, and said,

18 Lord, Lord, king who rules over all, because everything is in your authority, and there is no one opposing you when you wish to save Israel;

19 because you made heaven and earth and everything marveled at in the land under heaven, and you are Lord of all, and there is no one who will oppose you, the Lord.

20 You know everything; you know, Lord, that I did this, not bowing to the arrogant Aman, neither in insolence nor in arrogance nor in love of glory, because I was willing to kiss the soles of his feet for Israel's deliverance;

21 but I did this so that I might not place a man's glory above God's glory, and I will bow to no one except you, my Lord, and I will not do these things in arrogance.

22 And now, Lord God, king, God of Abraam, spare your people, because they look upon us for destruction and have desired to destroy your inheritance from the beginning;

23 do not overlook your portion, which you redeemed for yourself from the land of Egypt;

24 listen to my petition and be gracious to your allotted portion, and turn our mourning into feasting, so that while living we may sing your name, Lord, and do not make the mouth of those praising you disappear. –

25 And all Israel cried out with their strength, because their death was before their eyes.

17 k And Esther the queen took refuge with the Lord, seized in a struggle with death, and taking off the garments of her glory, put on garments of distress and mourning, and instead of proud perfumes filled her head with ashes and dung, and humbled her body greatly, and filled every place of her joyful adornment with her tangled hair, and petitioned the Lord God of Israel and said,

18 My Lord, our king, you alone are; help me who am alone and have no helper except you, because my danger is in my hand.

19 From my birth I heard in the tribe of my family that you, Lord, took Israel from all the nations and our fathers from all their ancestors as an eternal inheritance, and did for them all that you spoke.

20 And now we have sinned before you, and you have handed us over into the hands of our enemies, because we glorified their gods; you are just, Lord.

21 And now they have not been satisfied with the bitterness of our slavery, but have placed their hands upon the hands of their idols to remove the decree of your mouth and make your inheritance disappear and close the mouth of those praising you and extinguish the glory of your house and your altar

22 and open the mouth of nations for the excellences of vain things, and for a fleshly king to be marveled at forever.

23 Do not hand over your scepter, Lord, to those who do not exist, and let them not mock at our fall, but turn their plan upon them, and make an example of the one who began against us.

24 Remember, Lord; make yourself known in the time of our affliction, and give me courage, king of the gods and ruler over every authority;

25 give well-ordered speech into my mouth before the lion, and change his heart to hatred of the one warring against us, for his destruction and that of those of one mind with him;

26 but rescue us by your hand, and help me who am alone and have none except you, Lord.

27 You have knowledge of all things and know that I hated the glory of the lawless and abhor the bed of the uncircumcised and of every foreigner.

17 w You know my necessity, that I abhor the sign of my arrogance, which is upon my head in the days of my appearance; I abhor it as a menstrual rag, and do not wear it in the days of my quiet.

18 And your slave woman has not eaten Aman's table, and I have not glorified a king's drinking party, nor have I drunk wine of libations;

19 and your slave woman has not rejoiced from the day of my change until now except in you, Lord, God of Abraam.

20 God who is powerful over all, hear the voice of those who have lost hope, and rescue us from the hand of those doing evil; and rescue me from my fear.

Chapter 5

1 And it happened on the third day, when she ceased praying, that she took off the garments of service and clothed herself in her glory

1 a and, becoming splendid, called upon God, the overseer of all and savior, took the two maids, and leaned upon the one as though living delicately, while the other followed, lifting her clothing,

2 and she herself was rosy at the height of her beauty, and her face was cheerful as though lovely, but her heart was constricted by fear.

3 And passing through all the doors, she stood before the king, and he was sitting upon the throne of his kingdom and had put on all the attire of his splendor, entirely in gold and costly stones, and was exceedingly fearsome.

4 And lifting his face, inflamed with glory, he looked in the height of anger, and the queen fell and changed her color in faintness and bent down upon the head of the maid who went before her.

5 And God changed the king's spirit to gentleness, and in anguish he sprang from his throne and took her up into his arms until she recovered, and encouraged her with peaceful words and said to her,

6 What is it, Esther? I am your brother; take courage, you shall certainly not die, because our command is common; approach.

2 And lifting the golden rod, he placed it upon her neck and kissed her and said, Speak to me.

2 a And she said to him, I saw you, lord, as an angel of God, and my heart was troubled from fear of your glory; because you are marvelous, lord, and your face is full of graces.

3 But as she was speaking, she fell from her faintness, and the king was troubled, and all his attendants encouraged her. And the king said, What do you want, Esther, and what is your petition? As far as half my kingdom, and it shall be yours.

4 And Esther said, Today is a distinguished day for me; if therefore it seems good to the king, let both he and Aman come to the reception that I will hold today.

5 And the king said, Hurry Aman along, so that we may do Esther's word; and both arrive at the reception that Esther spoke of.

6 And during the drinking the king said to Esther, What is it, Queen Esther? And all that you request shall be yours.

7 And she said, My request and my petition;

8 if I have found favor before the king, let the king and Aman come tomorrow to the reception that I will hold for them, and tomorrow I will do the same things.

9 And Aman went out from the king exceedingly glad, rejoicing; but when Aman saw Mardochaios the Jew in the court, he became exceedingly angry.

10 And entering his own place, he called his friends and Zosara his wife

11 and showed them his wealth and the glory that the king had bestowed upon him, and how he had made him take first place and lead the kingdom.

12 And Aman said, The queen has called no one to the reception with the king except me, and I have been called for tomorrow;

13 and these things do not please me whenever I see Mardochaios the Jew in the court.

14 And Zosara his wife and his friends said to him, Let a timber of fifty cubits be cut for you, and at dawn speak to the king, and let Mardochaios be hung upon the timber; but you enter the reception with the king and rejoice. And the word pleased Aman, and the timber was prepared.

Chapter 6

1 But the Lord removed sleep from the king that night, and he told his teacher to bring in writings, memorials of the days, to read to him.

2 And he found the writings written about Mardochaios, how he had reported to the king concerning the king's two eunuchs while they were keeping guard and seeking to lay hands upon Artaxerxes.

3 And the king said, What glory or favor have we done for Mardochaios? And the king's servants said, You have done nothing for him.

4 And while the king was inquiring about Mardochaios's goodwill, behold, Aman was in the court; and the king said, Who is in the court? But Aman had come in to tell the king to hang Mardochaios upon the timber that he had prepared.

5 And the king's servants said, Behold, Aman stands in the court; and the king said, Call him.

6 And the king said to Aman, What shall I do for the man whom I wish to glorify? And Aman said within himself, Whom does the king wish to glorify except me?

7 And he said to the king, A man whom the king wishes to glorify,

8 let the king's servants bring a fine linen robe that the king wears, and a horse upon which the king mounts,

9 and let him give them to one of the king's illustrious friends, and let him clothe the man whom the king loves, and mount him upon the horse and proclaim through the city's square, saying, Thus shall it be for every man whom the king glorifies.

10 And the king said to Aman, As you have spoken, so do for Mardochaios the Jew who serves in the court, and let no word of what you have spoken fall aside from you.

11 And Aman took the robe and the horse and clothed Mardochaios and mounted him upon the horse and went through the city's square and proclaimed, saying, Thus shall it be for every man whom the king wishes to glorify.

12 And Mardochaios returned to the court, but Aman returned to his own place grieving, with his head covered.

13 And Aman recounted what had happened to him to Zosara his wife and his friends, and his friends and his wife said to him, If Mardochaios is of the race of Jews, you have begun to be humbled before him; falling you shall fall; you shall certainly not be able to ward him off, because a living God is with him. –

14 While they were still speaking, the eunuchs arrive, hurrying Aman to the drinking that Esther had prepared.

Chapter 7

1 And the king and Aman entered to drink with the queen.

2 And on the second day, during the drinking, the king said to Esther, What is it, Queen Esther, and what is your request and what is your petition? And let it be yours, as far as half my kingdom.

3 And answering, she said, If I have found favor before the king, let my life be given at my request, and my people at my petition;

4 for both I and my people were sold for destruction and plundering and slavery, we and our children as male slaves and female slaves, and I kept silent; for the slanderer is not worthy of the king's court.

5 And the king said, Who is this who dared to do this thing?

6 And Esther said, An enemy, this wicked Aman. But Aman was troubled because of the king and the queen.

7 But the king rose from the drinking party into the garden; and Aman entreated the queen, for he saw himself being in troubles.

8 And the king returned from the garden, but Aman had fallen upon the couch, petitioning the queen; and the king said, So you even assault the wife in my house? And on hearing this Aman was confounded in his face.

9 And Bougathan, one of the eunuchs, said to the king, Behold, Aman also prepared a timber for Mardochaios, who spoke concerning the king, and a timber of fifty cubits stands upright at Aman's place. And the king said, Let him be crucified upon it.

10 And Aman was hung upon the timber that he had prepared for Mardochaios. And then the king abated his anger.

Chapter 8

1 And on that very day King Artaxerxes gave Esther all that belonged to Aman the slanderer, and Mardochaios was summoned by the king, for Esther had explained that he was related to her.

2 And the king took the ring that he had removed from Aman and gave it to Mardochaios, and Esther appointed Mardochaios over all Aman's possessions.

3 And she spoke further to the king and fell at his feet and petitioned him to remove Aman's wickedness and all that he had done to the Jews.

4 And the king extended the golden rod to Esther, and Esther arose to stand before the king.

5 And Esther said, If it seems good to you and I have found favor, let an order be sent to reverse the letters sent by Aman, written for the destruction of the Jews who are in your kingdom;

6 for how shall I be able to see the mistreatment of my people, and how shall I be able to be saved at the destruction of my homeland?

7 And the king said to Esther, If I have given and granted you all Aman's possessions, and hung him upon a timber because he brought his hands against the Jews, what do you still seek?

8 You yourselves also write in my name as seems good to you, and seal with my ring; for whatever is written at the king's command and sealed with my ring cannot be contradicted.

9 And the scribes were called in the first month, which is Nisa, on the twenty-third of the same year, and there was written for the Jews all that he commanded the stewards and the rulers of the satraps, from India to Ethiopia, to one hundred twenty-seven satrapies, region by region, according to their own speech.

10 And it was written through the king and sealed with his ring, and they sent out the letters through letter carriers,

11 as he commanded them to use their laws in every city, both to help themselves and to deal with their adversaries and those opposing them as they wished,

12 on one day throughout Artaxerxes's kingdom, on the thirteenth of the twelfth month, which is Adar.

12 a The following is a copy of their letter:

13 Great King Artaxerxes to the rulers of regions in the one hundred twenty-seven satrapies from India to Ethiopia, and to those who are of our mind, greetings.

14 Many, honored more frequently by the abundant kindness of their benefactors, have become more high-minded, and not only seek to do evil to those subjected to us, but, unable to bear their surfeit, attempt to devise schemes against their own benefactors;

15 and not only abolishing gratitude from among people, but also lifted up by the boasts of those inexperienced in goodness, they suppose they will escape the evil-hating justice of God who always surveys everything.

13 And often the persuasion of friends entrusted to handle affairs has also made many appointed in positions of authority complicit in innocent blood and surrounded them with incurable calamities,

14 when those friends deceived the untainted good judgment of those in power by the false reasoning of their maliciousness.

15 And it is possible to examine, not so much from the older accounts that we have handed down, as by your investigating the things close at hand, what has been impiously accomplished by the pestilence of those wielding power unworthily,

16 and to attend to what follows, with a view to our providing the kingdom undisturbed to all people with peace,

17 making use of changes, but always judging the things coming before our eyes with a more equitable response.

12 k For Aman, son of Amadathos, a Macedonian, truly foreign to the blood of the Persians and far removed from our kindness, having been received as a guest by us,

13 obtained the humanity that we have toward every nation to such an extent that he was proclaimed our father and, bowed to by all, continued as the second person of the royal throne;

14 but not bearing his arrogance, he undertook to deprive us of rule and breath,

15 having requested for destruction, by intricately woven deceptive reasonings of schemes, both Mardochaios, our savior and continual benefactor, and Esther, the blameless partner of the kingdom, together with their entire nation;

16 for by these means he thought, after taking us bereft, to transfer the dominion of the Persians to the Macedonians.

17 But we find that the Jews handed over for disappearance by the thrice-accursed man are not evildoers, but conduct their lives under most just laws,

18 and are sons of the highest, greatest, living God, who directs the kingdom for both us and our ancestors in the finest arrangement.

19 You will therefore do well not to make further use of the letters sent by Aman son of Amadathos, because the very man who accomplished these things has been crucified at the gates of Sousa with his entire household, God who rules over everything having swiftly rendered him the judgment he deserved;

20 but after posting a copy of this letter in every place, to allow the Jews openly to use their own ordinances and to strengthen them together, so that they may ward off those who attacked them in a time of affliction on the thirteenth of the twelfth month, Adar, on that same day;

21 for God who has dominion over all has made this day gladness for them instead of destruction of the chosen race.

22 You yourselves therefore also celebrate a distinguished day with every kind of feasting among your named festivals, so that both now and afterward there may be deliverance for us and for the Persians of goodwill, but for those plotting against us a memorial of destruction.

12 x But every city or region as a whole that does not act according to these things will be consumed with spear and fire in wrath; it will be made not only impassable to people, but also most hateful to beasts and birds for all time.

13 And let the copies be posted visibly throughout the kingdom, and let all the Jews be ready for this day to fight their opponents.

14 The horsemen therefore went out, hastening to accomplish the things spoken by the king; and the command was also posted in Sousa.

15 And Mardochaios went out clothed in the royal robe and wearing a golden crown and a purple fine linen diadem; and those in Sousa rejoiced on seeing him.

16 And light and gladness came to the Jews;

17 in every city and region where the command was posted, where the proclamation was posted, there was joy and gladness for the Jews, drinking and gladness, and many of the nations were circumcised and practiced Judaism because of fear of the Jews.

Chapter 9

1 For in the twelfth month, on the thirteenth of the month, which is Adar, the letters written by the king were present.

2 On that very day those opposing the Jews perished; for no one resisted, fearing them.

3 For the rulers of the satraps and the potentates and the royal scribes honored the Jews; for the fear of Mardochaios lay upon them.

4 For the king's command came for him to be named throughout the kingdom.

6 And in the city of Sousa the Jews killed five hundred men,

7 both Pharsannestain and Delphon and Phasga

8 and Phardatha and Barea and Sarbacha

9 and Marmasima and Arouphaios and Arsaios and Zabouthaithan,

10 the ten sons of Aman son of Amadathos, the Bougaian, the enemy of the Jews, and plundered. –

11 On that very day the number of those who had perished in Sousa was delivered to the king.

12 And the king said to Esther, The Jews have destroyed five hundred men in the city of Sousa; but how do you think they dealt in the surrounding region? What then do you still petition, and it shall be yours?

13 And Esther said to the king, Let the Jews be permitted to act likewise tomorrow, so as to hang Aman's ten sons.

14 And he permitted it to happen thus and published an order for the Jews of the city to hang the bodies of Aman's sons.

15 And the Jews in Sousa assembled on the fourteenth of Adar and killed three hundred men and plundered nothing. –

16 But the rest of the Jews in the kingdom assembled and helped themselves and rested from their enemies; for they destroyed fifteen thousand of them on the thirteenth of Adar and plundered nothing.

17 And they rested on the fourteenth of the same month and celebrated it as a day of rest with joy and gladness.

18 But the Jews in the city of Sousa assembled also on the fourteenth and did not rest; and they celebrated the fifteenth also with joy and gladness.

19 Therefore the Jews scattered in every region outside celebrate the fourteenth of Adar as a good day with gladness, each sending portions to his neighbor; but those dwelling in the chief cities celebrate the fifteenth of Adar also as a day of good gladness, sending portions to their neighbors.

20 And Mardochaios wrote these words in a book and sent it to the Jews, as many as were in Artaxerxes's kingdom, those near and those far,

21 to establish these days as good days and to celebrate the fourteenth and the fifteenth of Adar –

22 for on these days the Jews rested from their enemies – and the month in which it was turned for them [which was Adar] from mourning to joy and from pain to a good day, to celebrate it entirely as good days of weddings and gladness, sending portions to friends and to the poor.

23 And the Jews accepted, as Mardochaios wrote to them,

24 how Aman son of Amadathos, the Macedonian, warred against them, how he established a decree and a lot to make them disappear,

25 and how he entered to the king, saying to hang Mardochaios; but all the evils he attempted to bring upon the Jews came upon him, and he and his children were hung.

26 Therefore these days were named Phrourai because of the lots, because in their language they are called Phrourai, because of the words of this letter and all that they have suffered because of these things and all that happened to them;

27 and he established it, and the Jews accepted it upon themselves and upon their seed and upon those added to them, and indeed they will not act otherwise; and these days are a memorial performed generation by generation and city and family and region;

28 and these days of Phrourai will be celebrated for all time, and their memorial shall certainly not fail from the generations.

29 And Esther the queen, daughter of Aminadab, and Mardochaios the Jew wrote all that they had done and the confirmation of the letter of Phrourai.

31 And Mardochaios and Esther the queen established for themselves against themselves, and then having established against their health, and their plan;

32 and Esther established it by a word forever, and it was written as a memorial.

Chapter 10

1 And the king prescribed taxes upon the kingdom of both land and sea.

2 And his strength and valor, and the wealth and glory of his kingdom, behold, it is written in the book of kings of Persians and Medes as a memorial.

3 But Mardochaios succeeded King Artaxerxes and was great in the kingdom and glorified by the Jews; and, being loved, he recounted his conduct to his entire nation.

3 a And Mardochaios said, These things came from God;

4 for I remembered concerning the dream that I saw concerning these matters; for not even a word of them passed away.

5 The little spring that became a river, and there was light and sun and much water; Esther is the river, whom the king married and made queen.

6 And the two dragons are I and Aman.

7 And the nations, those gathered together to destroy the name of the Jews.

8 And my nation, this is Israel, those who cried to God and were saved; and the Lord saved his people, and the Lord rescued us from all these evils, and God did the signs and the great wonders that have not happened among the nations.

9 Therefore he made two lots, one for God's people and one for all the nations;

10 and these two lots came to an hour and a time and to a day of judgment before God and among all the nations,

11 and God remembered his people and vindicated his inheritance.

3 k And these days shall be for them in the month Adar, on the fourteenth and the fifteenth of the same month, with assembly and joy and gladness before God throughout generations forever among his people Israel.

4 In the fourth year of Ptolemy and Cleopatra reigning, Dositheos, who said he was a priest and a Levite, and Ptolemy his son brought in the foregoing letter of Phrourai, which they said was genuine and that Lysimachos son of Ptolemy, of those in Jerusalem, had translated.

Judith

Chapter 1

1 In the twelfth year of the kingdom of Nabouchodonosor, who reigned over the Assyrians in Nineue, the great city, in the days of Arphaxad, who reigned over the Medes in Ekbatana,

2 and built walls around Ekbatana from hewn stones three cubits in width and six cubits in length, and made the height of the wall seventy cubits and its width fifty cubits,

3 and set its towers at its gates at one hundred cubits, and founded its width at sixty cubits,

4 and made its gates gates rising to a height of seventy cubits, and its width forty cubits, for the departures of the force of his mighty men and the formations of his infantry.

5 And in those days King Nabouchodonosor made war against King Arphaxad in the great plain, that is, a plain in the territory of Ragau.

6 And all who inhabited the hill country and all who inhabited the Euphrates and the Tigris and the Hydaspes and the plains of Arioch, king of the Elymaians, met with him, and many nations came together for the battle formation of the sons of Cheleoud.

7 And Nabouchodonosor, king of the Assyrians, sent to all who inhabited Persia and to all who inhabited the west, those inhabiting Cilicia and Damascus and Lebanon and Antilebanon, and all who inhabited the coastal frontage,

8 and those among the nations of Carmel and Galaad, and upper Galilee and the great plain of Esdrelon,

9 and all those in Samaria and its cities and beyond the Jordan as far as Jerusalem and Batane and Chelous and Kades and the river of Egypt and Taphnas and Ramesse and all the land of Gesem,

10 as far as coming above Tanis and Memphis, and all who inhabited Egypt as far as coming to the borders of Ethiopia.

11 And all who inhabited the entire land despised the word of Nabouchodonosor, king of the Assyrians, and did not come together with him for the war, because they did not fear him, but he was before them as a single man, and they sent his messengers back empty, with dishonor upon their faces.

12 And Nabouchodonosor became exceedingly angry against all this land and swore by his throne and his kingdom that he would indeed avenge himself upon all the territory of Cilicia and Damascus and Syria, to kill with his sword also all who inhabited the land of Moab and the sons of Ammon and all Judea and all those in Egypt as far as coming to the borders of the two seas.

13 And he drew up his force against King Arphaxad in the seventeenth year and prevailed in his war and overturned all Arphaxad's force and all his cavalry and all his chariots,

14 and became master of his cities and arrived as far as Ekbatana and seized the towers and plundered its squares and made its adornment its reproach,

15 and took Arphaxad in the mountains of Ragau and struck him down with his spears and destroyed him until that day.

16 And he himself and all his mixed company returned with them, an exceedingly great multitude of warrior men, and he was there relaxing and feasting, he and his force, for one hundred twenty days.

Chapter 2

1 And in the eighteenth year, on the twenty-second of the first month, a word came in the house of Nabouchodonosor, king of the Assyrians, to avenge himself upon all the land, as he had spoken.

2 And he called together all his attendants and all his grandees and laid before them the secret of his plan and concluded with his mouth all the evil for the land,

3 and they judged to destroy all flesh who had not followed the word of his mouth.

4 And it happened, when he concluded his plan, that Nabouchodonosor, king of the Assyrians, called Holophernes, the commander of his force, who was second after him, and said to him,

5 Thus says the great king, the lord of all the land: Behold, you shall go out from my presence and take with yourself men confident in their strength, infantry to one hundred twenty thousand, and a multitude of horses with riders, twelve thousand,

6 and you shall go out to meet all the land toward the west, because they disobeyed the word of my mouth,

7 and you shall tell them to prepare earth and water, because I will go out against them in my anger and cover the entire face of the land with the feet of my force, and I will give them to them for plundering,

8 and their wounded shall fill their ravines, and every torrent and overflowing river shall be filled with their dead;

9 and I will lead their captivity to the extremities of all the land.

10 But you shall go out and occupy all their territory beforehand for me, and they shall surrender themselves to you, and you shall preserve them for me for the day of their reproof;

11 but toward those disobeying, your eye shall not spare in giving them to slaughter and plunder in all your land.

12 Because I live, and the might of my kingdom, I have spoken and will do these things by my hand.

13 And you shall not transgress a single one of your lord's words, but accomplishing you shall accomplish as I have commanded you, and you shall not delay doing them.

14 And Holophernes went out from his lord's presence and called all the potentates and the generals and supervisors of Assour's force,

15 and counted chosen men for battle formation, as his lord commanded him, to one hundred twenty thousand, and mounted archers, twelve thousand,

16 and arranged them in the manner in which a multitude is arrayed for war.

17 And he took camels and asses and mules for their baggage, an exceedingly great multitude, and sheep and cattle and goats for their provision, of which there was no number,

18 and food supplies for every man in abundance, and exceedingly much gold and silver from the king's house.

19 And he himself and all his force went out on a march to go before King Nabouchodonosor and cover the entire face of the land toward the west with chariots and cavalry and their chosen infantry;

20 and a great mixed company went out together with them, like locusts and like the sand of the earth, for there was no number because of their multitude.

21 And they went away from Nineue a journey of three days to the front of the plain of Bektileth, and encamped from Bektileth near the mountain to the left of upper Cilicia.

22 And he took all his force, the infantry and the cavalry and his chariots, and went away from there into the hill country.

23 And he cut through Phoud and Loud and plundered all the sons of Rassis and the sons of Ismael facing the wilderness south of Cheleon.

24 And he crossed the Euphrates and went through Mesopotamia and demolished all the fortified cities upon the torrent Abrona, as far as coming to the sea.

25 And he occupied the territory of Cilicia and cut down all who resisted him and came as far as the territory of Iapheth, toward the south, facing Arabia.

26 And he encircled all the sons of Madiam and burned their dwellings and plundered their enclosures.

27 And he went down into the plain of Damascus in the days of the wheat harvest and burned all their fields and gave the flocks and herds to destruction, and despoiled their cities and winnowed away their plains and struck all their young men with the mouth of the sword. –

28 And fear and trembling of him fell upon those inhabiting the coast, those in Sidon and Tyre and those inhabiting Sour and Okina and all who inhabited Iemnaan, and those inhabiting Azotos and Askalon feared him exceedingly.

Chapter 3

1 And they sent messengers to him with peaceful words, saying,

2 Behold, we, the servants of Nabouchodonosor the great king, lie before you; deal with us as is pleasing to your face;

3 behold, our farmsteads and every place of ours and every plain of wheat and the flocks and herds and all the enclosures of our tents lie before your face; use them as may please you;

4 behold, our cities also and those dwelling in them are your slaves; come and meet them as is good in your eyes.

5 And the men arrived before Holophernes and reported to him according to these words.

6 And he and his force went down to the coast and garrisoned the fortified cities and took chosen men from them for an alliance;

7 and they and all their surrounding region received him with wreaths and dances and drums.

8 And he demolished all their territory and cut down their groves, and it had been granted him to destroy all the gods of the land, so that all the nations might serve him alone, Nabouchodonosor, and all their tongues and tribes might call upon him as god.

9 And he came facing Esdrelon, near Dotaia, which is opposite the great ridge of Judea,

10 and they encamped between Gaibai and the city of the Scythians, and he was there a month of days to gather all the baggage of his force.

Chapter 4

1 And the sons of Israel inhabiting Judea heard everything that Holophernes, the commander of Nabouchodonosor, king of the Assyrians, had done to the nations, and how he had despoiled all their sacred places and given them to destruction,

2 and they feared exceedingly, exceedingly, before him, and were troubled concerning Jerusalem and the temple of the Lord their God.

3 Because they had recently come up from captivity, and all the people of Judea had newly been gathered, and the vessels and the altar and the house had been sanctified from profanation.

4 And they sent into all the territory of Samaria and Kona and Baithoron and Belmain and Iericho, and to Choba and Aisora and the valley of Salem,

5 and occupied beforehand all the summits of the high mountains and walled the villages in them and stored supplies for food in preparation for war, because their plains had recently been harvested.

6 And Ioakim the great priest, who was in Jerusalem in those days, wrote to those dwelling in Baityloua and Baitomesthaim, which is opposite Esdrelon, facing the plain near Dothaim,

7 telling them to hold the ascents of the hill country firmly, because through them was the entrance into Judea, and it was easy to prevent them from approaching, the approach being narrow enough for two men in all.

8 And the sons of Israel did as Ioakim the great priest and the council of elders of the entire populace of Israel, who sat in Jerusalem, had directed them. –

9 And every man of Israel cried to God with great earnestness and humbled their souls with great earnestness.

10 They and their wives and their infants and their cattle and every resident alien and hired worker and purchased slave of theirs put sackcloth upon their loins.

11 And every man of Israel and woman and the children inhabiting Jerusalem fell before the temple and put ashes upon their heads and spread their sackcloth before the Lord;

12 and they clothed the altar with sackcloth and cried earnestly with one accord to the God of Israel, that he should not give their infants to plundering and the women to spoil and the cities of their inheritance to destruction and the holy places to profanation and reproach, an object of malicious joy for the nations.

13 And the Lord heard their voice and looked upon their affliction; and the people were fasting many days throughout Judea and Jerusalem before the holy places of the Lord Almighty.

14 And Ioakim the great priest and all the priests standing before the Lord and those ministering to the Lord, their loins girded with sackcloth, offered the continual whole burnt offering and the vows and the people's voluntary gifts,

15 and ashes were upon their turbans, and they cried to the Lord with all their strength to visit the entire house of Israel for good.

Chapter 5

1 And it was reported to Holophernes, commander of Assour's force, that the sons of Israel had prepared for war and closed the passes of the hill country and walled every summit of a high mountain and placed obstacles in the plains.

2 And he became exceedingly angry in wrath and called all the rulers of Moab and the generals of Ammon and all the satraps of the coast,

3 and said to them, Tell me now, sons of Chanaan, who this people is that sits in the hill country, and what cities they inhabit, and the multitude of their force, and in what their might and their strength consist, and who has arisen over them as king, leading their army,

4 and why they have turned their backs, so as not to come to meet me, beyond all those dwelling in the west. –

5 And Achior, the leader of all the sons of Ammon, said to him, Let my lord now hear a word from the mouth of your slave, and I will report to you the truth concerning this people that inhabits this hill country, dwelling near you, and no falsehood will go out from the mouth of your slave.

6 This people are descendants of Chaldeans.

7 And formerly they resided in Mesopotamia, because they did not wish to follow the gods of their fathers, who were in the land of the Chaldeans;

8 and they stepped out of the way of their parents and bowed to the God of heaven, a God whom they recognized, and they drove them out from before their gods, and they fled into Mesopotamia and resided there many days.

9 And their God told them to go out from their residence and travel to the land of Chanaan, and they dwelt there and increased in gold and silver and exceedingly many cattle.

10 And they went down into Egypt, for famine covered the face of the land of Chanaan, and they resided there as long as they were sustained; and they became a great multitude there, and there was no number of their race.

11 And the king of Egypt rose against them and dealt craftily with them in toil and brick; they humbled them and made them slaves.

12 And they cried to their God, and he struck all the land of Egypt with plagues in which there was no healing; and the Egyptians drove them out from before them.

13 And God dried up the Red Sea before them

14 and led them into the way of Sina and Kades Barne; and they drove out all those inhabiting the wilderness

15 and dwelt in the land of the Amorrites and destroyed all the Esebonites by their strength. And crossing the Jordan, they inherited all the hill country

16 and drove out from before them the Chanaanite and the Pherezite and the Iebousite and Sychem and all the Gergesaians, and dwelt in it many days.

17 And as long as they did not sin before their God, good things were with them, because a God who hates injustice is with them.

18 But when they departed from the way that he appointed for them, they were destroyed in many wars to an exceedingly great extent and taken captive into a land not their own, and the temple of their God was brought to the ground, and their cities were seized by their adversaries.

19 And now, returning to their God, they came up from the dispersion where they had been scattered, and occupied Jerusalem, where their sanctuary is, and settled in the hill country, because it was deserted.

20 And now, master, lord, if there is an ignorant offense among this people and they sin against their God, and we shall examine whether this obstacle is among them, and we shall go up and wage war against them;

21 but if there is no lawlessness in their nation, let my lord now pass by, lest their Lord and their God shield them, and we shall become a reproach before all the land. –

22 And it happened, when Achior ceased speaking these words, that all the people encircling the tent and standing around grumbled, and Holophernes's grandees and all those inhabiting the coast and Moab said to cut him to pieces:

23 For we shall not fear the sons of Israel, for behold, a people in whom there is neither force nor might for a strong battle formation;

24 therefore we shall now go up, and they shall be food for all your army, Master Holophernes. –

Chapter 6

1 And when the uproar of the men around the council ceased, Holophernes, commander of Assour's force, said to Achior before the entire populace of foreigners and to all the sons of Moab,

2 And who are you, Achior and the hired men of Ephraim, that you have prophesied among us as today and said not to war against the race of Israel, because their God will shield them? And who is god except Nabouchodonosor? He will send his might and destroy them from the face of the earth, and their God will not rescue them;

3 but we his slaves will strike them as a single person, and they will not withstand the might of our horses.

4 For we shall burn them up with them, and their mountains will be drunk with their blood, and their plains will be filled with their dead, and the footprint of their feet will not resist before us, but with destruction they will perish, says King Nabouchodonosor, lord of all the land; for he has spoken, the utterances of his words will not be made vain.

5 But you, Achior, hired man of Ammon, who spoke these words on the day of your injustice, shall no longer see my face from this day until I avenge myself upon the race of those from Egypt;

6 and then the iron of my army and the people of my attendants will pass through your sides, and you will fall among their wounded when I return.

7 And my slaves will take you back into the hill country and place you in one of the cities of the ascents,

8 and you will not perish until you are destroyed with them.

9 And if indeed you hope in your heart that they will not be seized, let your face not fall; I have spoken, and nothing of my words will fall away. –

10 And Holophernes commanded his slaves who stood in his tent to seize Achior and take him back to Baityloua and hand him over into the hands of the sons of Israel.

11 And his slaves seized him and led him outside the camp into the plain and set out from the midst of the plain into the hill country and arrived at the springs that were below Baityloua.

12 And when the men of the city on the summit of the mountain saw them, they took up their weapons and went out of the city onto the summit of the mountain, and every slinger held their ascent and threw stones at them.

13 And slipping beneath the mountain, they bound Achior and left him thrown down at the foot of the mountain and went away to their lord.

14 But the sons of Israel came down from their city and came upon him, and unbinding him, led him away into Baityloua and placed him before the rulers of their city,

15 who in those days were Ozias son of Micha, from the tribe of Symeon, and Chabris son of Gothoniel and Charmis son of Melchiel.

16 And they called together all the elders of the city, and all their young men and the women ran together into the assembly, and they stood Achior in the midst of all their people, and Ozias asked him what had happened.

17 And answering, he reported to them the words of Holophernes's council and all the words that he spoke in the midst of the rulers of the sons of Assour, and all that Holophernes spoke boastfully against the house of Israel.

18 And falling, the people bowed to God and cried, saying,

19 Lord, God of heaven, look down upon their arrogances and have mercy upon the humiliation of our race, and look upon the face of those sanctified to you on this day.

20 And they encouraged Achior and praised him exceedingly,

21 and Ozias took him from the assembly into his house and held a drinking for the elders, and they called upon the God of Israel for help throughout that night.

Chapter 7

1 And on the next day Holophernes ordered all his army and all his people who had come for his alliance to break camp toward Baityloua and occupy the ascents of the hill country beforehand and make war against the sons of Israel.

2 And on that day every mighty man of theirs broke camp; and their force of warrior men was one hundred seventy thousand infantry and twelve thousand cavalry, apart from the baggage and the men who were on foot among them, an exceedingly great multitude.

3 And they encamped in the valley near Baityloua, at the spring, and extended in width toward Dothaim as far as Belbaim, and in length from Baityloua as far as Kyamon, which is opposite Esdrelon.

4 But the sons of Israel, when they saw their multitude, were exceedingly troubled, and each said to his neighbor, Now these will lick up the face of all the land, and neither the high mountains nor the ravines nor the hills will withstand their weight.

5 And each took up their war equipment and lit fires upon their towers, and they remained keeping guard throughout that night.

6 And on the second day Holophernes led out all his cavalry before the sons of Israel who were in Baityloua,

7 and inspected the ascents of their city and surveyed the springs of water and occupied them beforehand and stationed camps of warrior men over them, and he himself broke camp toward his people. –

8 And all the rulers of the sons of Esau and all the leaders of the people of Moab and the generals of the coast approached him and said,

9 Let our master now hear a word, so that there may be no crushing in your force.

10 For this people of the sons of Israel trust not in their spears, but in the heights of the mountains in which they dwell; for it is not easy to approach the summits of their mountains.

11 And now, master, do not war against them as a war of battle formation takes place, and not one man of your people will fall.

12 Remain at your camp, preserving every man of your force, and let your servants take possession of the spring of water that goes out from the foot of the mountain,

13 because all who inhabit Baityloua draw water from there, and thirst will kill them, and they will surrender their city; and we and our people will go up onto the nearby summits of the mountains and encamp upon them as an outpost, so that not one man may go out of the city.

14 And they and their wives and their children will waste away in famine, and before the sword comes upon them, they will be laid low in the squares of their dwelling place.

15 And you will repay them an evil repayment because they rebelled and did not meet your face in peace. –

16 And their words pleased Holophernes and all his attendants, and he directed them to do as they had spoken.

17 And a camp of the sons of Ammon set out, and with them five thousand sons of Assour, and they encamped in the valley and occupied beforehand the waters and the springs of the waters of the sons of Israel.

18 And the sons of Esau and the sons of Ammon went up and encamped in the hill country opposite Dothaim. And they sent some of them toward the south and east, opposite Egrebel, which is near Chous, which is upon the torrent Mochmour. And the rest of the army of the Assyrians encamped in the plain and covered the entire face of the land, and their tents and their baggage encamped in a great crowd and were an exceedingly great multitude.

19 And the sons of Israel cried to the Lord their God, because their spirit had become fainthearted, because all their enemies had encircled them and there was no escaping from their midst.

20 And all Assour's camp, the infantry and chariots and their cavalry, remained around them thirty-four days. And all their water vessels failed all who inhabited Baityloua,

21 and the cisterns were being emptied, and they did not have water to drink to satisfaction for a single day, because they gave them drink by measure.

22 And their infants became dispirited, and the women and the young men failed from thirst and fell in the squares of the city and in the passages of the gates, and there was no strength left in them. –

23 And all the people gathered against Ozias and the rulers of the city, the young men and the women and the children, and cried with a loud voice and said before all the elders,

24 May God judge between you and us, because you have done great injustice among us by not speaking peaceful words with the sons of Assour.

25 And now there is no helper for us, but God has sold us into their hands, to be laid low before them in thirst and great destruction.

26 And now call upon them and surrender the entire city as spoil to Holophernes's people and all his force.

27 For it is better for us to become plunder for them; for we shall become slaves, and our life will live, and we shall not see the death of our infants before our eyes and our wives and our children giving up their lives.

28 We call heaven and earth and our God and Lord of our fathers to witness to you, who punishes us according to our sins and according to the sins of our fathers, that he may not act according to these words on this day today.

29 And there was great weeping in the midst of the assembly, all with one accord, and they cried to the Lord God with a loud voice. –

30 And Ozias said to them, Take courage, brothers; let us persevere five more days, in which the Lord our God will turn his mercy upon us, for he will not abandon us completely;

31 but if these pass and help does not come upon us, I will act according to your words.

32 And he dispersed the people to their own encampment, and they went away onto the walls and towers of their city and sent the women and the children into their houses; and they were in great humiliation in the city.

Chapter 8

1 And in those days Ioudith heard, daughter of Merari, son of Ox, son of Ioseph, son of Oziel, son of Elkia, son of Ananias, son of Gedeon, son of Raphain, son of Achitob, son of Elias, son of Chelkias, son of Eliab, son of Nathanael, son of Salamiel, son of Sarasadai, son of Israel.

2 And her husband Manasses was of her tribe and her family; and he died in the days of the barley harvest;

3 for he stood over those binding the sheaves in the plain, and the scorching heat came upon his head, and he fell upon his bed and died in Baityloua, his city, and they buried him with his fathers in the field between Dothaim and Balamon.

4 And Ioudith was in her house as a widow for three years and four months.

5 And she made herself a tent upon the roof of her house and put sackcloth upon her loins, and the garments of her widowhood were upon her.

6 And she fasted all the days of her widowhood except the days before sabbaths and sabbaths and the days before new moons and new moons and festivals and rejoicings of the house of Israel.

7 And she was beautiful in form and exceedingly lovely in appearance; and Manasses her husband had left her gold and silver and male slaves and female slaves and cattle and fields, and she remained over them.

8 And there was no one who brought an evil word against her, because she feared God exceedingly. –

9 And she heard the people's evil words against the ruler, because they had become fainthearted in the shortage of water, and Ioudith heard all the words that Ozias spoke to them, how he swore to them to hand the city over to the Assyrians after five days;

10 and sending her maid who was in charge of all her possessions, she called Chabris and Charmis, the elders of her city,

11 and they came to her, and she said to them, Hear me now, rulers of those inhabiting Baityloua; because your word that you spoke before the people on this day is not upright, and you established this oath that you spoke between God and yourselves, and said you would surrender the city to our enemies unless the Lord turned help to you within them.

12 And now who are you who have tested God on this day today and stand above God in the midst of the sons of men?

13 And now you examine the Lord Almighty, and you will know nothing forever.

14 Because you will not find the depth of a person's heart and will not discern the words of his mind; and how will you search God, who made all these things, and know his mind and understand his reasoning? By no means, brothers; do not provoke the Lord our God to anger.

15 Because if he does not wish to help us within the five days, he himself has the authority to shelter us on whatever days he wishes, or even to destroy us before our enemies.

16 But do not take the plans of the Lord our God as a pledge, because God is not like a person to be threatened, nor like a son of man to be brought to arbitration.

17 Therefore, awaiting the deliverance from him, let us call upon him for our help, and he will hear our voice if it is pleasing to him.

18 Because neither in our generations has there arisen nor on this day today is there any tribe or family or populace or city among us who bow to gods made by hands, as happened in the former days;

19 on account of which our fathers were given to the sword and to plundering and fell in a great fall before our enemies.

20 But we have known no other God except him; therefore we hope that he will not overlook us, nor any of our race.

21 Because when we are taken, thus all Judea also will be taken, and our holy places will be plundered, and he will exact their profanation from our blood,

22 and he will turn the slaughter of our brothers and the captivity of the land and the desolation of our inheritance upon our head among the nations, wherever we serve as slaves there, and we shall become a stumbling block and a reproach before those acquiring us.

23 Because our slavery will not be directed toward favor, but the Lord our God will make it dishonor.

24 And now, brothers, let us show our brothers that their life hangs upon us, and the holy places and the house and the altar rest upon us.

25 Besides all these things, let us give thanks to the Lord our God, who tests us as he also tested our fathers.

26 Remember all that he did with Abraam and all the ways he tested Isaak and all that happened to Iakob in Mesopotamia of Syria while shepherding the sheep of Laban, his mother's brother.

27 Because not as he tried them by fire for the examination of their heart, and he has not punished us, but the Lord scourges those approaching him for admonition. –

28 And Ozias said to her, All that you said, you spoke with a good heart, and there is no one who will resist your words;

29 because your wisdom is not evident only today, but from the beginning of your days all the people have known your understanding, because the formation of your heart is good.

30 But the people have thirsted exceedingly and compelled us to do as we spoke to them and to bring upon ourselves an oath that we will not transgress.

31 And now petition on our behalf, because you are a devout woman, and the Lord will send rain to fill our cisterns, and we shall no longer fail.

32 And Ioudith said to them, Hear me, and I will do a deed that will reach generations of generations for the sons of our race.

33 You shall stand at the gate this night, and I will go out with my maid, and within the days after which you said you would hand the city over to our enemies, the Lord will visit Israel by my hand;

34 but you shall not investigate my action, for I will not tell you until what I am doing is accomplished.

35 And Ozias and the rulers said to her, Go in peace, and the Lord God be before you for vengeance upon our enemies.

36 And returning from the tent, they went to their appointed posts.

Chapter 9

1 But Ioudith fell upon her face and put ashes upon her head and uncovered the sackcloth that she had put on, and the incense of that evening was just being offered in Jerusalem in the house of God, and Ioudith cried with a loud voice to the Lord and said,

2 Lord, God of my father Symeon, to whom you gave a sword in his hand for vengeance upon foreigners who loosened a virgin's womb for defilement and uncovered a thigh for shame and profaned a womb for reproach; for you said, It shall not be thus, and they did it;

3 because of which you gave their rulers to slaughter and their bedding, which had respected their deceit, deceived into blood, and struck slaves along with potentates and potentates upon their thrones,

4 and gave their wives as spoil and their daughters into captivity and all their spoils for division among sons loved by you, who also were zealous with your zeal and abhorred the defilement of their blood and called upon you as helper; God, my God, hear me also, the widow.

5 For you made the things before those and those things and the things afterward, and conceived the things now and the things coming, and what you thought came to be,

6 and what you planned stood forth and said, Behold, we are here; for all your ways are ready, and your judgment is in foreknowledge.

7 For behold, the Assyrians have multiplied in their force, have been exalted in horse and rider, have boasted in the arm of infantry, have hoped in shield and spear and bow and sling, and have not known that you are the Lord who crushes wars.

8 Lord is your name; shatter their strength by your power and break their might in your anger; for they have planned to profane your holy places, to defile the dwelling of the resting place of the name of your glory, to cast down the horn of your altar with iron.

9 Look upon their arrogance; send your wrath upon their heads; give into my hand, the widow's, the might that I have conceived.

10 Strike a slave along with a ruler from the lips of my deceit, and a ruler along with his attendant; break their exaltation by the hand of a female.

11 For your might is not in multitude, nor your dominion among the strong, but you are God of the lowly, helper of the lesser, supporter of the weak, shelterer of those given up, savior of the hopeless.

12 Yes, yes, God of my father and God of Israel's inheritance, master of the heavens and the earth, creator of the waters, king of all your creation, hear my petition,

13 and make my speech and deceit a wound and a bruise for those who have planned harsh things against your covenant and your sanctified house and the summit of Sion and the house possessed by your sons.

14 And bring about recognition among all your nation and every tribe, to know that you are God, God of all power and might, and there is no other who shields the race of Israel except you.

Chapter 10

1 And it happened, when she ceased crying to the God of Israel and concluded all these words,

2 that she rose from her prostration and called her maid and went down into the house in which she stayed on sabbath days and at her festivals,

3 and removed the sackcloth that she had put on and took off the garments of her widowhood and washed her body with water and anointed herself with thick perfume and combed the hair of her head and put a headband upon it and put on the garments of her gladness, in which she clothed herself in the days of the life of her husband Manasses,

4 and took sandals for her feet and put on her anklets and bracelets and rings and earrings and all her adornment, and beautified herself exceedingly to deceive the eyes of men, as many as might see her.

5 And she gave her maid a wineskin of wine and a flask of oil, and filled a bag with barley meal and a cake of pressed fruit and clean loaves, and wrapped all her vessels and placed them upon her.

6 And they went out to the gate of the city of Baityloua and found Ozias and the elders of the city, Chabris and Charmis, standing at it;

7 but when they saw her, and her face was altered and her attire changed, they marveled exceedingly greatly at her beauty and said to her,

8 May the God of our fathers grant you favor and complete your undertakings for the pride of the sons of Israel and the exaltation of Jerusalem.

9 And she bowed to God and said to them, Command that the gate of the city be opened for me, and I will go out to accomplish the words that you spoke with me; and they directed the young men to open it for her as she had spoken.

10 And they did thus. And Ioudith went out, she and her slave girl with her; and the men of the city watched her from afar until she went down the mountain, until she passed through the valley and they no longer saw her. –

11 And they traveled straight ahead in the valley, and an outpost of the Assyrians met her.

12 And they seized her and asked, Of whom are you, and from where do you come, and where do you go? And she said, I am a daughter of the Hebrews, and I am fleeing from before them, because they are about to be given to you as food;

13 and I am coming into the presence of Holophernes, commander of your force, to report words of truth, and I will show before him a way by which he will travel and become master of all the hill country, and not one flesh of his men nor a breath of life will be lost.

14 But when the men heard her words and observed her face – and it was exceedingly marvelous in beauty before them – they said to her,

15 You have saved your life by hastening to come down into the presence of our lord; and now approach his tent, and some of us will escort you until they hand you over into his hands;

16 but when you stand before him, do not fear in your heart, but report according to your words, and he will treat you well.

17 And they chose one hundred men from themselves and joined them to her and her maid, and led them to Holophernes's tent.

18 And there was a running together throughout the camp, for her arrival was proclaimed through the dwellings; and coming, they encircled her as she stood outside Holophernes's tent, until they reported to him concerning her.

19 And they marveled at her beauty and marveled at the sons of Israel because of her, and each said to his neighbor, Who will despise this people, who has such women among itself? For it is not good to leave a single man of them remaining, who, if released, will be able to outwit all the land,

20 and those sleeping beside Holophernes and all his attendants came out and led her into the tent.

21 And Holophernes was resting upon his couch within the mosquito net, which was of purple and gold and emerald and costly stones interwoven.

22 And they reported to him concerning her, and he went out into the front of the tent, and silver lamps went before him.

23 But when Ioudith came before him and his attendants, they all marveled at the beauty of her face; and falling upon her face, she bowed to him, and his slaves raised her.

Chapter 11

1 And Holophernes said to her, Take courage, woman; do not fear in your heart, because I have not mistreated a person who has chosen to serve King Nabouchodonosor of all the land.

2 And now, if your people inhabiting the hill country had not despised me, I would not have raised my spear against them; but they themselves did these things to themselves.

3 And now tell me for what reason you fled from them and came to us; for you have come for deliverance; take courage, you will live this night and afterward;

4 for there is no one who will wrong you, but he will treat you well, as happens to the slaves of my lord King Nabouchodonosor.

5 And Ioudith said to him, Receive the words of your slave woman, and let your slave girl speak before your face, and I will not report a falsehood to my lord this night.

6 And if you follow the words of your slave girl, God will accomplish a deed with you completely, and my lord will not fall short of his undertakings.

7 For King Nabouchodonosor of all the land lives, and his might lives, who sent you for the setting right of every soul, because not only do people serve him through you, but also the beasts of the field and the cattle and the birds of heaven will live through your strength under Nabouchodonosor and all his house.

8 For we heard your wisdom and the cunning deeds of your soul, and it was reported to all the land that you alone are good in all the kingdom and powerful in knowledge and marvelous in armies of war.

9 And now the word that Achior spoke in your council, we have heard his words, because the men of Baityloua preserved him, and he reported to them all that he spoke out beside you.

10 Therefore, master, lord, do not pass over his word, but place it in your heart, because it is true; for our race is not punished, nor does a sword prevail against them, unless they sin against their God.

11 And now, so that my lord may not become driven off and unsuccessful, and death will fall upon their face, and a sin has overtaken them, by which they will provoke their God to anger whenever they commit an improper deed.

12 Since their foods have failed them and all water has become scarce, they planned to lay hands upon their cattle and resolved to consume everything that God instructed them by his laws not to eat.

13 And the firstfruits of grain and the tithes of wine and oil that they kept safe, consecrating them for the priests standing in Jerusalem before the face of our God, they have judged to consume entirely, things that not even with the hands was it proper for anyone of the people to touch.

14 And they have sent to Jerusalem, because those dwelling there also did these things, those who will bring them the permission from the council of elders.

15 And it will be, when he reports to them and they do it, that they will be given to you for destruction on that day.

16 Therefore I, your slave woman, learning all these things, fled from before them, and God sent me to do deeds with you at which all the land will be astonished, as many as hear them.

17 Because your slave woman is God-fearing and serves the God of heaven night and day; and now I will remain beside you, my lord, and your slave woman will go out by night into the ravine, and I will pray to God, and he will tell me when they have committed their sins.

18 And coming, I will report to you, and you will go out with all your force, and there is no one among them who will resist you.

19 And I will lead you through the midst of Judea as far as coming before Jerusalem, and I will place your seat in its midst, and you will lead them as sheep who have no shepherd, and no dog will growl with its tongue before you; because these things were spoken to me according to my foreknowledge and reported to me, and I was sent to report to you. –

20 And her words pleased Holophernes and all his attendants, and they marveled at her wisdom and said,

21 There is no such woman from end to end of the land in beauty of face and understanding of words.

22 And Holophernes said to her, God did well by sending you before the people, so that might might come into our hands, but destruction among those who despised my lord.

23 And now you are lovely in your form and good in your words; because if you do as you have spoken, your God will be my God, and you will sit in King Nabouchodonosor's house and will be renowned throughout all the land.

Chapter 12

1 And he commanded that she be brought in where his silverware was placed, and directed that a table be spread for her from his prepared dishes and that she drink from his wine.

2 And Ioudith said, I will not eat of them, so that there may be no stumbling block, but provision will be made from the things that have followed me.

3 And Holophernes said to her, But if the things with you run out, from where shall we bring out for you to give things like them? For there is no one of your race with us.

4 And Ioudith said to him, Your life lives, my lord, that your slave woman will not consume the things with me until the Lord does by my hand what he has planned.

5 And Holophernes's attendants led her into the tent, and she slept until the middle of the night; and she arose toward the morning watch.

6 And she sent to Holophernes, saying, Let my lord now command that your slave woman be allowed to go out for prayer;

7 and Holophernes commanded the bodyguards not to prevent her. And she remained in the camp three days; and she went out by night into the ravine of Baityloua and immersed herself in the camp at the spring of water;

8 and when she came up, she petitioned the Lord God of Israel to direct her way toward the raising up of the sons of his people;

9 and entering clean, she remained in the tent until she took her food toward evening.

10 And it happened on the fourth day that Holophernes held a drinking for his slaves alone and called none of those attending to duties to the invitation.

11 And he said to Bagoas the eunuch, who was in charge of all his possessions, Go now and persuade the Hebrew woman who is beside you to come to us and eat and drink with us;

12 for behold, it is shameful to our face if we let such a woman pass without having intercourse with her; because if we do not draw her to ourselves, she will mock us.

13 And Bagoas went out from Holophernes's presence and came in to her and said, Let this beautiful slave girl now not hesitate to come to my lord to be glorified before his face, and you shall drink wine with us for gladness and become on this day as one daughter of the sons of Assour who stand in Nabouchodonosor's house.

14 And Ioudith said to him, And who am I to contradict my lord? For everything that is pleasing in his eyes I will hasten to do, and this will be my rejoicing until the day of my death.

15 And rising, she adorned herself with clothing and all her feminine adornment, and her slave woman approached and spread on the ground for her opposite Holophernes the fleeces that she had received from Bagoas for her daily way of life, to eat reclining upon them.

16 And entering, Ioudith reclined, and Holophernes's heart was beside itself over her, and his soul was shaken, and he was exceedingly desirous to have intercourse with her; and he watched for an opportunity to deceive her from the day he saw her.

17 And Holophernes said to her, Drink now and be with us in gladness.

18 And Ioudith said, I will indeed drink, lord, because my living has been magnified in me today beyond all the days of my birth.

19 And taking, she ate and drank before him what her slave woman had prepared.

20 And Holophernes rejoiced because of her and drank exceedingly much wine, as much as he had never yet drunk on a single day since he was born.

Chapter 13

1 But when evening came, his slaves hastened to depart. And Bagoas closed the tent from outside and shut out those attending from before his lord, and they went away to their beds; for they were all wearied because the drinking had gone on longer.

2 But Ioudith was left alone in the tent, and Holophernes fallen forward upon his couch; for the wine had flooded him.

3 And Ioudith told her slave woman to stand outside her bedchamber and watch for her departure as each day, for she said she would go out for her prayer; and she spoke to Bagoas according to these words.

4 And they all went away from before her, and no one was left in the bedchamber, from small to great; and Ioudith, standing beside his couch, said in her heart, Lord, God of all power, look upon the works of my hands at this hour for Jerusalem's exaltation;

5 because now is a time to support your inheritance and to carry out my undertaking for the crushing of enemies who have risen against us.

6 And approaching the bed rail that was at Holophernes's head, she took down his short sword from it,

7 and approaching the couch, grasped the hair of his head and said, Strengthen me, Lord, God of Israel, on this day.

8 And she struck into his neck twice with her strength and removed his head from him.

9 And she rolled his body off the bedding and removed the mosquito net from the posts; and after a little while she went out and handed Holophernes's head to her maid,

10 and she put it into her food bag. And the two went out together for prayer according to their custom; and passing through the camp, they went around that ravine and went up the mountain of Baityloua and came to its gates.

11 And Ioudith said from afar to those guarding at the gates, Open, open the gate now; God, our God, is with us, to do strength again in Israel and might against the enemies, as he has also done today.

12 And it happened, when the men of her city heard her voice, that they hastened to go down to the gate of their city and called together the elders of the city.

13 And they all ran together, from small to great among them, because her coming was unexpected to them, and they opened the gate and received them and, lighting a fire for illumination, encircled them.

14 But she said to them with a loud voice, Praise God, praise; praise God, who has not removed his mercy from the house of Israel, but has crushed our enemies through my hand this night.

15 And taking the head out of the bag, she showed it and said to them, Behold, the head of Holophernes, commander of Assour's force, and behold, the mosquito net in which he lay in his drunkenness; and the Lord struck him by the hand of a female;

16 and the Lord lives, who preserved me in my way on which I traveled, that my face deceived him for his destruction, and he committed no sin with me for defilement and shame.

17 And all the people were exceedingly astonished and bent down and bowed to God and said with one accord, Blessed are you, our God, who has brought the enemies of your people to nothing on this day today.

18 And Ozias said to her, Blessed are you, daughter, by God Most High beyond all the women upon the earth, and blessed is the Lord God who created the heavens and the earth, who directed you to wound the head of the ruler of our enemies;

19 because your hope will not depart from the heart of people remembering God's strength forever;

20 and may God do these things for you for eternal height, to visit you with good things, because you did not spare your life on account of the humiliation of our race, but came forth against our fall, traveling straight before our God. And all the people said, May it be, may it be.

Chapter 14

1 And Ioudith said to them, Hear me now, brothers, and take this head and hang it upon the battlement of your wall.

2 And it shall be, when dawn shines through and the sun comes out upon the earth, each of you will take up your equipment for war, and every strong man will go out of the city, and you will give them a leader as though going down upon the plain to the outpost of the sons of Assour, and you will not go down.

3 And these men, taking up their full armor, will go to their camp and awaken the generals of the force of Assour; and they will run together to the tent of Olophernes and will not find him, and fear will fall upon them, and they will flee from before you.

4 And you and all who inhabit every territory of Israel, following after them, lay them low in their roads.

5 But before doing these things, call for me Achior the Ammanite, so that, seeing, he may recognize the one who despised the house of Israel and sent him to us as though to death.

6 And they called Achior from the house of Ozias; and when he came and saw the head of Olophernes in the hand of one man in the assembly of the people, he fell upon his face, and his spirit failed.

7 And when they lifted him up, he fell at the feet of Ioudith and bowed before her face and said, Blessed are you in every dwelling of Iouda and in every nation, who, hearing your name, will be troubled;

8 and now tell me all that you did in these days. And Ioudith told him in the midst of the people everything that she had done from the day she went out until she was speaking to them.

9 And when she ceased speaking, the people shouted with a great voice and gave a joyful cry in their city.

10 And Achior, seeing everything that the God of Israel had done, believed in God exceedingly and circumcised the flesh of his foreskin and was added to the house of Israel until this day.

11 And when dawn arose, they hung the head of Olophernes from the wall, and every man took up his weapons, and they went out in companies onto the ascents of the mountain.

12 And when the sons of Assour saw them, they sent to their leaders; and these came to the generals and commanders of thousands and to every ruler of theirs.

13 And they came to the tent of Olophernes and said to the one who was over everything of his, Awaken our lord now, because the slaves have dared to come down against us for war, so that they may be utterly destroyed.

14 And Bagoas went in and struck the curtain of the tent; for he supposed that he was sleeping with Ioudith.

15 And when no one answered, he parted it and entered the bedchamber and found him cast dead upon the bedframe, and his head had been removed from him.

16 And he cried out with a great voice, with weeping and groaning and a mighty cry, and tore his garments.

17 And he went into the tent where Ioudith had been lodging and did not find her; and he sprang out to the people and cried out,

18 The slaves have acted treacherously; one woman of the Hebrews has brought shame upon the house of King Nabouchodonosor; for behold, Olophernes is on the ground, and his head is not upon him.

19 And when the rulers of the force of Assour heard these words, they tore their tunics, and their soul was exceedingly troubled, and their shouting and crying became exceedingly great in the midst of the camp.

Chapter 15

1 And when those in the dwellings heard, they were astounded at what had happened,

2 and trembling and fear fell upon them, and there was no man remaining before his neighbor any longer, but pouring out with one accord, they fled along every road of the plain and the hill country;

3 and those encamped in the hill country around Baityloua also turned to flight. And then the sons of Israel, every warrior among them, poured out upon them.

4 And Ozias sent to Baitomasthaim and Bebai and Chobai and Kola and to every territory of Israel those who would report concerning the things accomplished, and so that all might pour out upon the enemies to kill them.

5 And when the sons of Israel heard, they all fell upon them with one accord and cut them down as far as Choba. Likewise those from Jerusalem and from all the hill country also arrived, for they had reported to them what had happened to the camp of their enemies; and those in Galaad and those in Galilee outflanked them with a great blow until they passed Damascus and its territories.

6 And the rest who inhabited Baityloua fell upon the camp of Assour and plundered them and became exceedingly rich.

7 And the sons of Israel, returning from the slaughter, took possession of the remaining things, and the villages and farmsteads in the hill country and the plain gained much spoil, for there was an exceedingly great abundance.

8 And Ioakim the great priest and the council of elders of the sons of Israel who inhabited Jerusalem came to behold the good things which the Lord had done for Israel and to see Ioudith and speak peace with her.

9 And when they came in to her, they all blessed her with one accord and said to her, You are the exaltation of Jerusalem, you are the great pride of Israel, you are the great boast of our race;

10 you did all these things by your hand, you did good things with Israel, and God was pleased with them; be blessed by the almighty Lord for everlasting time. And all the people said, May it be.

11 And all the people plundered the camp for thirty days; and they gave Ioudith the tent of Olophernes and all the silverware and the beds and the basins and all his furnishings, and she took them and placed them upon her mule and yoked her wagons and heaped them upon them.

12 And every woman of Israel ran together to see her, and they blessed her and formed a dance of themselves for her, and she took thyrsi in her hands and gave them to the women with her;

13 and they crowned themselves with olive, she and those with her, and she went before all the people in a dance, leading all the women, and every man of Israel followed, armed and with crowns, and they sang hymns with their mouths.

14 And Ioudith led this thanksgiving in all Israel, and all the people sang out this praise

Chapter 16

1 and Ioudith said, Lead off for my God with tambourines, sing to the Lord with cymbals, fit together for him a psalm and praise, exalt and call upon his name,

2 because the Lord is a God who crushes wars, because into his camps in the midst of the people he rescued me from the hand of those pursuing me.

3 Assour came from mountains from the north; he came with myriads of his force, whose multitude blocked torrents, and their cavalry covered hills;

4 he said he would burn my territories and kill my young men with the sword and put my sucklings upon the ground and give my infants over to plunder and despoil my virgins.

5 The almighty Lord thwarted them by the hand of a female.

6 For their mighty man did not fall by young men, nor did sons of Titans strike him, nor did tall giants attack him, but Ioudith daughter of Merari disabled him by the beauty of her face,

7 for she took off the robe of her widowhood for the exaltation of those toiling in Israel, anointed her face with perfume

8 and bound her hair with a turban and took a linen robe to deceive him;

9 her sandal seized his eye, and her beauty took his soul captive; the short sword passed through his neck.

10 Persians shuddered at her daring, and Medes were troubled at her boldness;

11 then my lowly ones shouted, and my weak ones became afraid and were terrified; they lifted up their voice and were overturned;

12 sons of girls pierced them and wounded them as children of deserters; they perished by the battle array of my Lord.

13 I will sing a new hymn to my God: Lord, you are great and glorious, wonderful in strength, unsurpassable.

14 Let all your creation serve you; because you spoke, and they came to be; you sent forth your spirit, and it built; and there is no one who will resist your voice.

15 For mountains will be shaken from their foundations together with waters, and rocks will melt like wax before you; but still, to those who fear you, you will be gracious to them.

16 Because every sacrifice is a small thing for a fragrant odor, and all fat is a very little thing for a whole burnt offering to you; but the one who fears the Lord is great continually.

17 Woe to nations rising against my race; the almighty Lord will punish them on the day of judgment, to give fire and worms into their flesh, and they will weep in awareness for the age.

18 And when they came to Jerusalem, they worshiped God, and when the people were purified, they offered their whole burnt offerings and their voluntary offerings and gifts.

19 And Ioudith dedicated all the equipment of Olophernes which the people gave her, and the canopy which she took for herself from his bedchamber she gave as a dedication to God.

20 And the people were rejoicing in Jerusalem before the holy things for three months, and Ioudith remained with them.

21 And after these days each departed to his inheritance, and Ioudith went away to Baityloua and remained upon her property; and in her time she became glorious in all the land.

22 And many desired her, and no man knew her all the days of her life from the day Manasses her husband died and was added to his people.

23 And she advanced to a very great age and grew old in the house of her husband, one hundred five years; and she released her maidservant as a free woman. And she died in Baityloua, and they buried her in the cave of her husband Manasses,

24 and the house of Israel mourned her seven days. And she divided her possessions before she died among all the nearest relatives of Manasses her husband and the nearest relatives of her race.

25 And there was no longer anyone who terrified the sons of Israel in the days of Ioudith and for many days after her death.

1 Tobit

Chapter 1

1 Book of the words of Tobit, of Tobiel, of Ananiel, of Adouel, of Gabael, from the seed of Asiel, from the tribe of Nephthalim,

2 who was taken captive in the days of Enemessaros the king of the Assyrians from Thisbe, which is to the right of Kydios of Nephthalim in Galilee, above Aser.

3 I, Tobit, walked in ways of truth and righteousness all the days of my life and performed many acts of mercy for my brothers and the nation, those who traveled together with me to the country of the Assyrians, to Nineue.

4 And when I was in my country in the land of Israel, when I was younger, the whole tribe of Nephthalim my father departed from the house of Jerusalem, which was chosen from all the tribes of Israel for all the tribes to sacrifice; and the temple of the dwelling of the Most High was sanctified and built for all the generations of the age.

5 And all the tribes that departed together sacrificed to Baal the heifer, and the house of Nephthalim my father.

6 And I alone traveled many times to Jerusalem at the feasts, as it is written for all Israel in an eternal ordinance, having the firstfruits and the tithes of the produce and the first shearings;

7 and I gave them to the priests, the sons of Aaron, at the altar; of all the produce I gave the tithe to the sons of Leui who served in Jerusalem. And I sold the second tithe and traveled and spent these things in Jerusalem each year.

8 And I gave the third to those to whom it was due, as Debbora my father's mother commanded, because I was left an orphan by my father.

9 And when I became a man, I took Anna as a wife from the seed of our paternal family and begot Tobias by her.

10 And when I was taken captive to Nineue, all my brothers and those of my race ate of the breads of the nations;

11 but I guarded my soul against eating,

12 because I remembered God with my whole soul.

13 And the Most High gave favor and form before Enemessaros, and I was his buyer;

14 and I traveled to Media and deposited ten talents of silver with Gabael the brother of Gabrias in Ragoi of Media.

15 And when Enemessaros died, Sennacherim his son reigned in his place, and his roads became unsettled, and I was no longer able to travel to Media.

16 And in the days of Enemessaros I performed many acts of mercy for my brothers;

17 I gave my breads to the hungry and my garments to the naked, and if I saw anyone of my race dead and cast behind the wall of Nineue, I buried him.

18 And if Sennacherim the king killed anyone when he came fleeing from Judea, I buried them, stealing them; for he killed many in his anger; and the bodies were sought by the king and were not found.

19 And one of those in Nineue went and informed the king concerning me, that I bury them, and I hid; and learning that I was sought to be put to death, I withdrew in fear.

20 And all my possessions were plundered, and nothing was left to me except Anna my wife and Tobios my son.

21 And fifty days had not passed before his two sons killed him; and they fled to the mountains of Ararat, and Sacherdonos his son reigned in his place. And he appointed Achiacharos of Anael, son of my brother, over all the accounting of his kingdom and over all the administration.

22 And Achiacharos petitioned concerning me, and I came to Nineue. And Achiacharos was the cupbearer and in charge of the ring and administrator and accountant, and Sacherdonos appointed him a second time; and he was my cousin.

Chapter 2

1 And when I came down to my house and Anna my wife and Tobias my son were restored to me, at Pentecost, the feast which is holy, of seven weeks, a fine meal was prepared for me, and I reclined to eat.

2 And I beheld many dishes and said to my son, Go and bring whoever you find among our brothers in need, who remembers the Lord; and behold, I will wait for you.

3 And coming, he said, Father, one of our race has been strangled and cast into the marketplace.

4 And before tasting anything, I sprang up and took him up into a certain building until the sun set.

5 And returning, I bathed and ate my bread in grief;

6 and I remembered the prophecy of Amos, as he said, Your feasts will be turned into mourning and all your rejoicings into lamentation; and I wept.

7 And when the sun set, I went away and dug and buried him.

8 And the neighbors laughed, saying, He is no longer afraid of being murdered on account of this matter; and he ran away, and behold, again he buries the dead.

9 And that very night I returned after burying him and slept, defiled, beside the wall of the courtyard, and my face was uncovered;

10 and I did not know that little birds were in the wall, and while my eyes were open, the little birds deposited hot droppings into my eyes, and white films developed in my eyes. And I went to physicians, and they did not help me; and Achiacharos supported me until he traveled to Elymais.

11 And Anna my wife worked for hire at women's work;

12 and she sent it to the owners, and they themselves paid her the wage, also giving a kid in addition.

13 And when it came to me, it began to cry; and I said to her, Where is the little kid from? Surely it is not stolen? Return it to the owners; for it is not lawful to eat something stolen.

14 And she said, It has been given to me as a gift in addition to the wage. And I did not believe her and told her to return it to the owners and reddened toward her; and answering, she said to me, Where are your acts of mercy and your righteous deeds? Behold, everything is known with you.

Chapter 3

1 And grieved, I wept and prayed with anguish, saying,

2 You are righteous, Lord, and all your works and all your ways are acts of mercy and truth, and you judge a true and righteous judgment for the age.

3 Remember me and look upon me; do not punish me for my sins and my unwitting offenses and those of my fathers, which I committed before you;

4 for they disobeyed your commandments. You gave us over to plunder and captivity and death and a proverb of reproach to all the nations among which we have been scattered.

5 And now many of your judgments are true, to execute upon me concerning my sins and those of my fathers, because we did not perform your commandments; for we did not walk in truth before you.

6 And now do with me according to what is pleasing before you; command that my spirit be taken up, so that I may be released and become earth; because it profits me to die rather than live, because I heard false reproaches, and there is much grief in me; command that I be released from distress now to the eternal place; do not turn your face away from me.

7 On the same day it happened to Sarra the daughter of Ragouel in Ekbatana of Media that she too was reproached by her father's maidservants,

8 because she had been given to seven men, and Asmodaus the evil demon killed them before they were with her as with women. And they said to her, Do you not understand, strangling your husbands? You already had seven and benefited from none of them.

9 Why do you scourge us? If they died, go with them; may we not see a son or daughter of yours for the age.

10 Hearing these things, she grieved exceedingly, so as to hang herself. And she said, I am my father's only one; if I do this, it is a reproach to him, and I will bring his old age down with anguish into Hades.

11 And she petitioned beside the window and said, Blessed are you, Lord my God, and blessed is your holy and honored name for the ages; may all your works bless you for the age.

12 And now, Lord, I have directed my eyes and my face toward you;

13 command that I be released from the earth and no longer hear reproach.

14 You know, Lord, that I am clean from every sin of a man

15 and have not defiled my name or my father's name in the land of my captivity. I am my father's only child, and he has no child who will inherit from him, nor a brother nearby nor a son belonging to him, so that I may keep myself as a wife for him. Seven have already perished for me; why should I live? And if it does not seem good to you to kill me, command that I be looked upon and shown mercy and no longer hear reproach.

16 And the prayer of both was heard before the glory of the great Raphael,

17 and he was sent to heal the two, to peel away Tobit's white films and give Sarra of Ragouel to Tobias the son of Tobit as a wife and bind Asmodaus the evil demon, because it falls to Tobias to inherit her. At that very time Tobit returned and entered his house, and Sarra of Ragouel came down from her upper room.

Chapter 4

1 On that day Tobit remembered concerning the silver which he deposited with Gabael in Rhagoi of Media,

2 and said within himself, I asked for death; why do I not call Tobias my son, so that I may inform him before I die?

3 And calling him, he said, Child, if I die, bury me; and do not disregard your mother; honor her all the days of your life and do what is pleasing to her and do not grieve her.

4 Remember, child, that she has seen many dangers on account of you in the womb; when she dies, bury her beside me in one grave.

5 All the days, child, remember the Lord our God and do not desire to sin and transgress his commandments; do righteousness all the days of your life and do not walk in the ways of injustice;

6 because when you do truth, there will be prosperity in your works.

7 And to all who do righteousness, show mercy from your possessions, and let your eye not begrudge your showing mercy; do not turn your face away from any poor person, and the face of God will certainly not be turned away from you.

8 As you have possessions, according to their abundance show mercy from them; if you have little, do not be afraid to show mercy according to the little;

9 for you store up a good deposit for yourself for a day of distress;

10 because mercy delivers from death and does not allow one to enter into darkness;

11 for mercy is a good gift for all who perform it before the Most High.

12 Guard yourself, child, against all fornication, and first take a wife from the seed of your fathers; do not take a foreign wife who is not from your father's tribe, because we are sons of prophets. Noe, Abraam, Isaak, Iakob, our fathers from of old—remember, child, that all these took wives from their brothers and were blessed in their children, and their seed will inherit land.

13 And now, child, love your brothers and do not be arrogant in your heart toward your brothers and the sons and daughters of your people, to take a wife for yourself from them, because in arrogance there is destruction and much disorder, and in uselessness there is decrease and great need; for uselessness is the mother of famine.

14 Let the wage of every person who works not lodge with you, but pay him immediately, and if you serve God, it will be repaid to you. Guard yourself, child, in all your works, and be disciplined in all your conduct.

15 And what you hate, do to no one. Do not drink wine to drunkenness, and let drunkenness not travel with you on your road.

16 Give from your bread to a hungry person and from your garments to the naked; everything that is surplus for you, give in mercy, and let your eye not begrudge your showing mercy.

17 Pour out your breads upon the grave of the righteous and do not give to sinners.

18 Seek counsel from every prudent person and do not despise any useful counsel.

19 And at every time bless the Lord God and ask of him that your roads may become straight and all your paths and counsels prosper; because no nation has counsel, but the Lord himself gives all good things and humbles whomever he wishes, as he wills. And now, child, remember my commandments, and let them not be erased from your heart.

20 And now I show you the ten talents of silver which I deposited with Gabael of Gabrias in Rhagoi of Media.

21 And do not be afraid, child, because we have become poor; you have much if you fear God and depart from every sin and do what is pleasing before him.

Chapter 5

1 And answering, Tobias said to him, Father, I will do everything that you have commanded me;

2 but how will I be able to receive the silver, when I do not know him?

3 And he gave him the written bond and said to him, Seek for yourself a man who will travel with you, and I will give him a wage while I live; and go and receive the silver.

4 And he went to seek a man and found Raphael, who was an angel, and he did not know;

5 and he said to him, Can I travel with you in Rhagoi of Media, and are you experienced in the places?

6 And the angel said to him, I will travel with you, and I am experienced in the road, and I lodged with Gabael our brother.

7 And Tobias said to him, Wait for me, and I will tell my father.

8 And he said to him, Go, and do not delay.

9 And going in, he said to his father, Behold, I have found one who will travel with me. And he said, Call him to me, so that I may learn of which tribe he is and whether he is faithful to travel with you.

10 And he called him, and he went in, and they greeted one another.

11 And Tobit said to him, Brother, from which tribe and from which homeland are you? Inform me.

12 And he said to him, Are you seeking a tribe and paternal family or a hired man who will travel with your son? And Tobit said to him, I wish, brother, to learn your race and name.

13 And he said, I am Azarias of Ananias the great, of your brothers.

14 And he said to him, May you come in health, brother; and do not be angry with me because I sought to learn your tribe and paternal family. And you happen to be my brother from the fine and good lineage; for I knew Ananias and Iathan, the sons of Semeias the great, when we traveled together to Jerusalem to worship, bringing up the firstborn and the tithes of the produce, and they did not go astray in the error of our brothers. You are from a good root, brother.

15 But tell me what wage I shall give you: a drachma a day and your necessities, as also for my son?

16 And I will add still more to your wage if you return in health.

17 And they agreed thus. And he said to Tobias, Become ready for the road; and may you prosper. And his son prepared the things for the road. And his father said to him, Go with the man; and God who dwells in heaven will prosper your road, and let his angel travel with you. And both went out to depart, and the boy's dog with them.

18 And Anna his mother wept and said to Tobit, Why have you sent our child away? Is he not the staff of our hand as he goes in and goes out before us?

19 May silver not overtake silver, but may it become a thing cast away for our child;

20 for as living has been given to us by the Lord, this is sufficient for us.

21 And Tobit said to her, Do not be concerned, sister; he will come in health, and your eyes will see him;

22 for a good angel will travel with him, and his road will prosper, and he will return in health.

23 And she ceased weeping.

Chapter 6

1 And those traveling the road came in the evening to the Tigris river and lodged there.

2 And the boy went down to wash himself, and a fish sprang up from the river and wished to swallow the boy.

3 And the angel said to him, Take hold of the fish. And the boy seized the fish and cast it up onto the land.

4 And the angel said to him, Cut open the fish, and take the heart and the liver and the gall and put them away safely.

5 And the boy did as the angel told him, and roasting the fish, they ate.

6 And both traveled until they drew near in Ekbatana.

7 And the boy said to the angel, Azarias, brother, what are the liver and the heart and the gall of the fish?

8 And he said to him, The heart and the liver, if a demon or an evil spirit troubles anyone, these must be burned to make smoke before a man or woman, and that person will certainly no longer be troubled;

9 and the gall, to anoint a person who has white films in the eyes, and he will be healed.

10 And as they drew near to Rage,

11 the angel said to the boy, Brother, today we will lodge with Ragouel, and he is your relative, and he has an only daughter named Sarra;

12 I will speak concerning her being given to you as a wife, because her inheritance falls to you, and you alone are of her race; and the girl is beautiful and prudent.

13 And now hear me, and I will speak to her father, and when we return from Rhagoi, we will hold the wedding. Because I know Ragouel, that he will certainly not give her to another man according to the law of Moses, or he will owe death, because it belongs to you to receive the inheritance rather than any man.

14 Then the boy said to the angel, Azarias, brother, I have heard that the girl has been given to seven men and that all have perished in the bridal chamber.

15 And now I am my father's only one, and I am afraid lest I go in and die as also the former ones, because a demon loves her, which harms no one except those approaching her. And now I am afraid lest I die and bring the life of my father and my mother down with anguish over me into their grave; and they have no other son who will bury them.

16 And the angel said to him, Do you not remember the words which your father commanded you concerning taking a wife from your race? And now hear me, brother, because she will be your wife, and take no account of the demon, because this night she will be given to you as a wife.

17 And if you enter the bridal chamber, you will take ashes of incense and place some of the heart and the liver of the fish upon them and make smoke, and the demon will smell it and flee and will not return for the age of the age.

18 And when you approach her, arise, both of you, and cry out to the merciful God, and he will save you and have mercy; do not be afraid, because she was prepared for you from of old, and you will save her, and she will travel with you, and I suppose that you will have children by her.

19 And when Tobias heard these things, he loved her, and his soul clung to her exceedingly.

Chapter 7

1 And they came to Ekbatana and arrived at the house of Ragouel, and Sarra met them and greeted them, and they her, and she brought them into the house.

2 And Ragouel said to Edna his wife, How like Tobit my cousin the young man is.

3 And Ragouel asked them, Where are you from, brothers? And they said to him, From the sons of Nephthali, the captives in Nineue.

4 And he said to them, Do you know Tobit our brother? And they said, We know him.

5 And he said to them, Is he healthy? And they said, He both lives and is healthy; and Tobias said, He is my father.

6 And Ragouel sprang up and kissed him and wept and blessed him and said to him, You of the fine and good man; and hearing that Tobit had lost his eyes, he grieved and wept.

7 And Edna his wife and Sarra his daughter wept and welcomed them eagerly.

8 And they slaughtered a ram of the sheep and set several dishes before them.

9 And Tobias said to Raphael, Azarias, brother, speak concerning the things you were saying on the journey, and let the matter be accomplished.

10 And he communicated the word to Ragouel. And Ragouel said to Tobias, Eat and drink and be glad; for it belongs to you to take my child; nevertheless I will show you the truth.

11 I gave my child to seven men, and whenever they went in to her, they died during the night. But for the present, be glad.

12 And Tobias said, I will taste nothing here until you establish it and stand with me. And Ragouel said, Take her from now according to the judgment; and you are her brother, and she is yours; and the merciful God will prosper the best things for you.

13 And he called Sarra his daughter and took her hand and gave her to Tobias as a wife and said, Behold, according to the law of Moses take her and lead her away to your father; and he blessed them.

14 And he called Edna his wife; and taking a document, he wrote a contract, and they sealed it. And they began to eat.

15 And Ragouel called Edna his wife and said to her, Sister, prepare the other chamber and bring her in.

16 And she did as he said and brought her there and wept; and she received her daughter's tears and said to her,

17 Take courage, child; may the Lord of heaven and earth give you favor in place of this grief of yours; take courage, daughter.

Chapter 8

1 And when they finished dining, they brought Tobias in to her.

2 And as he went, he remembered Raphael's words and took the ashes of the incense and placed the fish's heart and liver upon them and made smoke.

3 And when the demon smelled the odor, it fled to the uppermost parts of Egypt, and the angel bound it.

4 And when both were shut in together, Tobias arose from the bed and said, Arise, sister, and let us pray, so that the Lord may have mercy on us.

5 And Tobias began to say, Blessed are you, God of our fathers, and blessed is your holy and glorious name for the ages; may the heavens and all your creations bless you.

6 You made Adam and gave him Eua as a helper, a support, his wife; from these came the seed of people. You said, It is not good for the man to be alone; let us make him a helper like him.

7 And now, Lord, I take this sister of mine because of truth, not because of fornication; command that I be shown mercy and grow old together with her.

8 And she said with him, Amen.

9 And both slept the night.

10 And Ragouel arose and went and dug a grave, saying, Lest this one also die.

11 And Ragouel came to his house

12 and said to Edna his wife, Send one of the maidservants, and let them see whether he lives; and if not, so that we may bury him and no one know.

13 And the maidservant went in, opening the door, and found the two sleeping.

14 And going out, she reported to them that he lives.

15 And Ragouel blessed God, saying, Blessed are you, God, with every pure and holy blessing, and let your holy ones and all your creations bless you, and let all your angels and your chosen ones bless you for all the ages.

16 Blessed are you because you gladdened me, and it did not happen to me as I supposed, but according to your abundant mercy you dealt with us.

17 Blessed are you because you showed mercy to two only children; show them mercy, Master; bring their life to completion in health with gladness and mercy.

18 And he ordered the household servants to fill in the grave.

19 And he held a wedding for them of fourteen days.

20 And before the days of the wedding were completed, Ragouel told him under oath that he was not to go out unless the fourteen days of the wedding were fulfilled,

21 and then to take half his possessions and travel in health to his father; and the remaining things, when I and my wife die.

Chapter 9

1 And Tobias called Raphael and said to him,

2 Azarias, brother, take with yourself a servant and two camels and travel to Gabael in Rhagoi of Media and bring me the silver and lead him to the wedding;

3 because Ragouel has sworn that I am not to go out,

4 and my father counts the days, and if I delay greatly, he will be exceedingly distressed.

5 And Raphael traveled and lodged with Gabael and gave him the written bond; and he brought out the little bags with their seals and gave them to him.

6 And they arose early together and came to the wedding. And Tobias blessed his wife.

Chapter 10

1 And Tobit his father calculated each day; and when the days of the journey were fulfilled and they did not come,

2 he said, Perhaps they have been put to shame? Or perhaps Gabael died and no one gives him the silver?

3 And he grieved greatly.

4 And his wife said to him, The child has perished, because he has delayed; and she began to lament him and said,

5 Does it not concern me, child, that I let you go, the light of my eyes?

6 And Tobit says to her, Be silent, do not be concerned; he is healthy.

7 And she said to him, Be silent, do not deceive me; my child has perished. And each day she went out to the road by which he had departed, and by day she ate no bread, and at night she did not cease lamenting Tobias her son, until the fourteen days of the wedding were completed, which Ragouel swore to have him spend there.

8 And Tobias said to Ragouel, Send me away, because my father and my mother no longer hope to see me.

9 And his father-in-law said to him, Remain with me, and I will send to your father, and they will tell him the things concerning you. And Tobias says, No, but send me away to my father.

10 And Ragouel arose and gave him Sarra his wife and half the possessions, persons and livestock and silver;

11 and blessing them, he sent them away, saying, The God of heaven will prosper you, children, before I die.

12 And he said to his daughter, Honor your parents-in-law; they are now your parents; may I hear a good report of you. And he kissed her.

13 And Edna said to Tobias, Beloved brother, may the Lord of heaven restore you and grant me to see your children from Sarra my daughter, so that I may rejoice before the Lord; and behold, I entrust my daughter to you as a deposit; do not grieve her.

14 After these things Tobias traveled, blessing God because he prospered his road, and he blessed Ragouel and Edna his wife.

Chapter 11

1 And he traveled until they drew near to Nineue. And Raphael said to Tobias,

2 Do you not know, brother, how you left your father?

3 Let us run ahead of your wife and prepare the house;

4 and take the fish's gall ready at hand. And they traveled, and the dog went along behind them.

5 And Anna sat looking about along the road for her child;

6 and she noticed him coming and said to his father, Behold, your son is coming, and the man who traveled with him.

7 And Raphael said, I know that your father will open his eyes;

8 you, therefore, anoint the gall into his eyes, and stung, he will rub them and cast off the white films and see you.

9 And Anna ran forward and fell upon her son's neck and said to him, I have seen you, child; from now I shall die. And both wept.

10 And Tobit went out toward the door and stumbled, and his son ran forward to him

11 and took hold of his father and sprinkled the gall upon his father's eyes, saying, Take courage, father.

12 And when they were stung, he rubbed his eyes, and the white films peeled away from the corners of his eyes.

13 And seeing his son, he fell upon his neck and wept and said,

14 Blessed are you, God, and blessed is your name for the ages, and blessed are all your holy angels; because you scourged me and showed me mercy, behold, I see Tobias my son.

15 And his son entered rejoicing and reported to his father the great things that had happened to him in Media.

16 And Tobit went out to meet his bride, rejoicing and blessing God, at the gate of Nineue; and those who beheld him walking marveled because he could see, and Tobit gave thanks before them because God had shown him mercy.

17 And when Tobit approached Sarra his bride, he blessed her, saying, May you come in health, daughter; blessed is God who brought you to us, and your father and your mother.

18 And there was joy for all his brothers in Nineue.

19 And Achiacharos and Nasbas his cousin arrived, and Tobias's wedding was held with gladness for seven days.

Chapter 12

1 And Tobit called Tobias his son and said to him, See, child, to a wage for the man who went with you, and it is necessary to add to it for him.

2 And he said to him, Father, I am not harmed by giving him half of what I have brought,

3 because he has brought me to you healthy and healed my wife and brought my silver and likewise healed you.

4 And the old man said, It is his due.

5 And he called the angel and said to him, Take half of everything that you have brought.

6 Then calling the two privately, he said to them, Bless God and give thanks to him; give him greatness and give thanks before all the living concerning what he did with you; it is good to bless God and exalt his name, honorably making known the accounts of God's works, and do not hesitate to give thanks to him.

7 It is good to hide a king's secret, but to reveal God's works gloriously. Do good, and evil will not find you.

8 Prayer with fasting and mercy and righteousness is good; a little with righteousness is better than much with injustice; it is better to show mercy than to store up gold.

9 For mercy delivers from death, and it will cleanse away every sin; those who perform acts of mercy and righteous deeds will be filled with life;

10 but those who sin are enemies of their own life.

11 I will certainly not hide any word from you; I have indeed said, It is good to hide a king's secret, but to reveal God's works gloriously.

12 And now, when you and Sarra your bride prayed, I brought the memorial of your prayer before the Holy One; and when you buried the dead, I was likewise present with you.

13 And when you did not hesitate to arise and leave your meal so that you might go away and wrap the dead man, you did not escape my notice as you did good, but I was with you.

14 And now God sent me to heal you and Sarra your bride.

15 I am Raphael, one of the seven holy angels who bring up the prayers of the holy ones and enter before the glory of the Holy One.

16 And the two were troubled and fell upon their faces, because they were afraid.

17 And he said to them, Do not be afraid; there will be peace for you; and bless God for the age.

18 Because I came by the will of our God, not by my own favor; therefore bless him for the age.

19 All the days I appeared to you, and I neither ate nor drank, but you beheld a vision.

20 And now give thanks to God, because I ascend to the one who sent me, and write everything accomplished in a book.

21 And they arose; and they no longer saw him.

22 And they gave thanks for the great and wonderful works of God and how the angel of the Lord appeared to them.

Chapter 13

1 And Tobit wrote a prayer for exultation and said,

2 Blessed is God who lives for the ages, and his kingdom, because he scourges and has mercy, brings down into Hades and brings up, and there is no one who will escape his hand.

3 Give thanks to him, sons of Israel, before the nations, because he scattered us among them;

4 there show his greatness; exalt him before every living being, because he is our Lord and God; he is our Father for all the ages.

5 And he will scourge us in our injustices and again have mercy and gather us from all the nations, wherever you may have been scattered among them.

6 If you return to him with your whole heart and with your whole soul to do truth before him, then he will return to you and will certainly not hide his face from you.

7 And behold what he will do with you, and give thanks to him with your whole mouth; and bless the Lord of righteousness and exalt the King of the ages.

8 I give thanks to him in the land of my captivity and show his strength and his greatness to a nation of sinners. Return, sinners, and do righteousness before him; who knows whether he will desire you and show mercy to you?

9 I exalt my God, and my soul the King of heaven, and it will exult in his greatness.

10 Let everyone speak and give thanks to him in Jerusalem. Jerusalem, holy city, he will scourge on account of the works of your sons and again have mercy on the sons of the righteous.

11 Give thanks to the Lord well and bless the King of the ages, so that his tent may again be built for you with joy.

12 And may he gladden the captives in you and love the afflicted in you for all the generations of the age.

13 Many nations will come from afar to the name of the Lord God, having gifts in their hands and gifts for the King of heaven; generations of generations will give you exultation.

14 Accursed are all who hate you; blessed will all who love you be for the age.

15 Rejoice and exult over the sons of the righteous, because they will be gathered and will bless the Lord of the righteous; O blessed are those who love you; they will rejoice over your peace.

16 Blessed are all who grieved over all your scourges, because they will rejoice over you, having beheld all your glory, and will be glad for the age. Let my soul bless God, the great King.

17 Because Jerusalem will be built with sapphire and emerald and precious stone, your walls and the towers and the battlements with pure gold, and the broad streets of Jerusalem will be paved with beryl and carbuncle and stone from Souphir.

18 And all her lanes will say, Alleluia, and will praise, saying, Blessed is God, who exalted all the ages.

Chapter 14

1 And Tobit ceased giving thanks.

2 And he was fifty-eight years old when he lost his sight, and after eight years he saw again; and he performed acts of mercy and continued to fear the Lord God and give thanks to him.

3 And he grew very old; and he called his son and his sons and said to him, Child, take your sons; behold, I have grown old and am close to departing from life.

4 Go away to Media, child, because I am persuaded of all that Jonas the prophet spoke concerning Nineue, that it will be overthrown, but in Media there will rather be peace until a time, and that our brothers in the land will be scattered from the good land, and Jerusalem will be desolate, and the house of God in it will be burned down and will be desolate for a time.

5 And again God will have mercy on them and return them to the land, and they will build the house, not such as the former one, until the times of the age are fulfilled. And after these things they will return from the captivities and build Jerusalem honorably, and the house of God in it will be built for all the generations of the age with a glorious building, just as the prophets spoke concerning it.

6 And all the nations will truly turn to fear the Lord God and will bury their idols, and all the nations will bless the Lord.

7 And his people will give thanks to God, and the Lord will exalt his people, and all who love the Lord God in truth and righteousness will rejoice, showing mercy to our brothers.

8 And now, child, go away from Nineue, because what the prophet Jonas spoke will certainly happen.

9 But you, keep the law and the ordinances and become merciful and righteous, so that it may be well with you, and bury me well and your mother with me; and no longer lodge in Nineue.

10 Child, see what Aman did to Achiacharos who reared him, how he brought him from the light into the darkness, and all that he repaid him; and Achiacharos was saved, but to that man the repayment was paid, and he himself went down into the darkness. Manasses showed mercy and was saved from a snare of death which he set for him, but Aman fell into the snare and perished.

11 And now, children, see what mercy does, and what righteousness delivers. And while he was saying these things, his soul failed upon the bed; and he was one hundred fifty-eight years old; and he buried him gloriously.

12 And when Anna died, he buried her with his father. And Tobias went away with his wife and his sons to Ekbatana to Ragouel his father-in-law.

13 And he grew old honorably and buried his parents-in-law gloriously and inherited their property and that of Tobit his father.

14 And he died at one hundred twenty-seven years of age in Ekbatana of Media.

15 And before he died he heard of the destruction of Nineue, which Nabouchodonosor and Asyeros took captive; he rejoiced over Nineue before dying.

2 Tobit

Chapter 1

1 Book of the words of Tobith, of Tobiel, of Ananiel, of Adouel, of Gabael, of Raphael, of Ragouel, from the seed of Asiel, from the tribe of Nephthalim,

2 who was taken captive in the days of Enemessaros the king of the Assyrians, from Thisbe, which is on the right of Kydios of Nephthalim in upper Galilee, above Asser, behind the [road] of the settings of the sun, on the left of Phogor.

3 I, Tobith, walked in ways of truth and in righteous deeds all the days of my life, and I did many acts of mercy for my brothers and for my nation, those who went with me in captivity into the country of the Assyrians, into Nineue.

4 And when I was in my country, in the land of Israel, and when I was young, the whole tribe of Nephthalim my father departed from the house of Dauid my father and from Jerusalem, the city [chosen] out of all the tribes of Israel for all the tribes of Israel to sacrifice; and the temple of the dwelling of God was sanctified and built in it for all the generations of the age.

5 All my brothers and the house of Nephthalim my father, they sacrificed to the calf which Ierobeam the king of Israel made in Dan, on all the mountains of Galilee.

6 And I, most alone, often went to Jerusalem at the feasts, as it is written for all Israel in an everlasting ordinance; having the firstfruits and the first produce and the tithes of the livestock and the first shearings of the sheep, I hurried to Jerusalem

7 and gave them to the priests, the sons of Aaron, at the altar, and the tithe of the grain and the wine and oil and pomegranates and figs and the remaining tree fruits to the sons of Leui who ministered in Jerusalem. And I paid the second tithe in silver for the six years, and went and spent it in Jerusalem each year.

8 And I gave these to the orphans and the widows and proselytes who were attached to the sons of Israel; I brought them and gave them to them in the third year, and we ate them according to the ordinance prescribed concerning them in the law of Moses and according to the commands which Debbora, the mother of Ananiel our father, commanded, because my father left me an orphan and died.

9 And when I became a man, I took a wife from the seed of our family, and begot a son from her and called his name Tobias.

10 After I was taken captive among the Assyrians, and when I was taken captive, I went to Nineue; and all my brothers and those of my race ate of the breads of the nations,

11 but I kept my soul from eating of the breads of the nations.

12 And when I remembered my God with my whole soul,

13 and the Most High gave me favor and form before Enemessaros, and I bought for him everything for his use;

14 and I went to Media and bought for him from there until he died. And I deposited bags with Gabael, the brother, Gabri, in the country of Media, ten talents of silver.

15 And when Enemassar died and Sennacherim his son reigned in his place, and the roads of Media withdrew, and I could no longer go to Media.

16 In the days of Enemessaros I did many acts of mercy for my brothers of my race;

17 I gave my breads to the hungry and clothing to the naked, and if I saw anyone of my nation dead and cast behind the wall of Nineue, I buried him.

18 And if Sennacherim killed anyone when he went away fleeing from Judaea in the days of the judgment which the king of heaven executed upon him concerning the blasphemies which he blasphemed, I buried him; for he killed many of the sons of Israel in his wrath, and I stole their bodies and buried them; and Sennacherim sought them and did not find them.

19 And a certain one of those from Nineue went and informed the king about me, that I bury them, and I hid; and when I learned that the king knew about me and that I was being sought to die, I was afraid and ran away.

20 And everything that belonged to me was seized, and nothing was left to me that was not taken into the royal treasury, except Anna my wife and Tobias my son.

21 And forty days did not pass before his two sons killed him; and they fled to the mountains of Ararat, and Sacherdonos his son reigned after him. And he appointed Achicharos, Anael, the son of my brother, over all the accounting of his kingdom, and he had authority over all the administration.

22 Then Achicharos made a request concerning me, and I came down to Nineue. For Achicharos was the chief cupbearer and keeper of the ring and administrator and accountant under Sennacherim king of the Assyrians, and Sacherdonos appointed him a second time; and he was my cousin and of my kin.

Chapter 2

1 And under King Sacherdonos I came down to my house, and Anna my wife and Tobias my son were restored to me. And at Pentecost, our feast, which is holy, of [seven] weeks, a good meal was prepared for me, and I reclined to eat.

2 And the table was set before me, and more dishes were set before me, and I said to Tobias my son, Child, go, and whomever you find poor among our brothers from the captives in Nineue, who remembers with his whole heart, bring him, and he will eat together with me; and see, I will wait for you, child, until you come.

3 And Tobias went to seek someone poor among our brothers. And returning he says, Father. And I said to him, Here I am, child. And answering he said, Father, behold, one of our nation has been murdered and cast in the marketplace, and there now he has been strangled.

4 And leaping up I left the meal before tasting it, and I take him up from the street and placed him in one of the little houses until the sun sets, and I will bury him.

5 Returning, therefore, I washed myself and ate the bread with mourning;

6 and I remembered the word of the prophet, all that Amos spoke against Baithel, saying, Your feasts will be turned into mourning and all your songs into lamentation, and I wept.

7 And when the sun set, I went away and dug and buried him.

8 And my neighbors laughed at me, saying, He is no longer afraid; for he was already sought to be murdered because of this matter and ran away, and again, behold, he buries the dead.

9 And that very night I washed myself and entered my courtyard and slept beside the wall of the courtyard, and my face was uncovered because of the heat;

10 and I did not know that sparrows were in the wall above me, and their droppings settled warm into my eyes and brought on white films. And I went to the physicians to be healed, and the more they smeared me with the medicines, the more my eyes were blinded by the white films until I became completely blind; and I was disabled in my eyes for four years. And all my brothers grieved about me, and Achiacharos supported me for two years before he went to Elymais.

11 And at that time Anna my wife worked for wages at women's work;

12 and she sent it to its owners, and they paid her the wage. And on the seventh of Dystros she cut the cloth from the loom and sent it to the owners, and they gave her the whole wage and gave her a kid from the goats for the hearth.

13 And when she came in to me, the kid began to cry; and I called her and said, Where is this little kid from? Is it perhaps stolen? Return it to its owners; for we have no authority to eat anything stolen.

14 And she says to me, It has been given to me as a gift in addition to the wage. And I did not believe her and told her to return it to the owners, and I reddened toward her because of this; then answering she says to me, And where are your acts of mercy? Where are your righteous deeds? See, these things are known with you. –

Chapter 3

1 And becoming deeply grieved in soul and groaning, I wept and began to pray with groans,

2 You are righteous, Lord, and all your works are righteous, and all your ways are mercy and truth; you judge the age.

3 And now you, Lord, remember me and look upon me, and do not exact vengeance on me for my sins and in my ignorant offenses and those of my fathers, with which I sinned before you

4 and disobeyed your commands. And you gave us over to plunder and captivity and death and to a proverb and a topic of talk and reproach among all the nations among whom you scattered us.

5 And now your many judgments are true, to execute upon me concerning my sins, because we did not do your commands and did not walk truly before you.

6 And now do with me according to what is pleasing to you, and command my spirit to be taken from me, so that I may be released from the face of the earth and become earth; therefore it profits me to die rather than live, because I have heard false reproaches, and much grief is with me. Lord, command that I be released from this distress; release me to the everlasting place, and do not turn your face, Lord, away from me; therefore it profits me to die rather than see much distress in my life and not hear reproaches.

7 On this day it happened that Sarra, the daughter of Ragouel who was in Ecbatana of Media, also heard reproaches from one of her father's maidservants,

8 because she had been given to seven men, and Asmodaios the evil demon killed them before they were with her, just as is appointed for women. And the maidservant said to her, You are the one who kills your husbands; behold, you have already been given to seven men and were not named for one of them.

9 Why do you whip us concerning your husbands, because they died? Go with them, and may we never see a son of yours or a daughter forever.

10 On that day she was grieved in soul and wept, and going up into her father's upper room she wanted to hang herself. And again she considered and says, Perhaps they will reproach my father and say to him, You had one beloved daughter, and she hanged herself because of the evils; and I will bring my father's old age down with grief into Hades; it is more useful for me not to hang myself, but to beseech the Lord that I die and no longer hear reproaches in my life.

11 At that very time, spreading her hands toward the window, she beseeched and said, Blessed are you, merciful God, and blessed is your name unto the ages, and let all your works bless you forever.

12 And now I have lifted my face and my eyes toward you;

13 command that I be released from the earth and that I no longer hear reproaches.

14 You know, Master, that I am clean from every uncleanness of a man

15 and I have not defiled my name, nor my father's name, in the land of my captivity. I am my father's only child, and he has no other child to inherit him, nor has he a brother nearby or a relative, that I might keep myself as a wife for him. Already seven have perished for me, and why is it still for me to live? And if it does not seem good to you to kill me, Lord, now listen to my reproach.

16 At that very time the prayer of both was heard before the glory of God,

17 and Raphael was sent to heal the two, to release the white films from Tobin's eyes so that he might see the light of God with his eyes, and to give Sarra, Ragouel's daughter, to Tobias the son of Tobith as a wife, and to release Asmodaios the evil demon from her, because it falls to Tobias to inherit her before all those who want to take her. At that time Tobith returned from the courtyard into his house, and Sarra, Ragouel's daughter, also came down from the upper room.

Chapter 4

1 On that day Tobith remembered the silver which he had deposited with Gabael in Rhagoi of Media,

2 and said in his heart, Behold, I have asked for death; why do I not call Tobias my son and inform him about this silver before I die?

3 And he called Tobias his son, and he came to him; and he said to him, Bury me well; and honor your mother and do not abandon her all the days of her life, and do what is pleasing before her, and do not grieve her spirit in any matter.

4 Remember her, child, because she saw many dangers for you in her womb; and when she dies, bury her beside me in one grave.

5 And all your days, child, remember the Lord, and do not wish to sin and transgress his commands; do righteous deeds all the days of your life, and do not walk in the ways of unrighteousness;

6 because those who do truth will prosper in their works.

7 And to all those who do righteousness

19 the Lord will give good counsel; and whomever the Lord wishes, he humbles down to lowest Hades. And now, child, remember these commands, and let them not be blotted out of your heart.

20 And now, child, I inform you that I deposited ten talents of silver with Gabael, the son of Gabri, in Rhagoi of Media.

21 And do not fear, child, because we have become poor; you have many good things if you fear God and flee from every sin and do good things before the Lord your God.

Chapter 5

1 Then answering Tobias said to Tobith his father, Everything that you have commanded me I will do, father;

2 but how will I be able to receive it from him, when he does not know me and I do not know him? What sign should I give him, that he may recognize me and trust me and give me the silver? And I do not know the roads into Media, to go there.

3 Then answering Tobith said to Tobias his son, He gave me his handwritten document, and I gave him a handwritten document; and I divided it into two, and we each took one, and I placed it with the silver; and now, behold, twenty years have passed since I deposited this silver. And now, child, seek for yourself a trustworthy man who will go with you, and we will give him a wage until you come; and receive this silver from him.

4 And Tobias went out to seek a man who would go with him to Media, who was experienced in the road, and he went out and found Raphael the angel standing opposite him, and did not know that he was an angel of God;

5 and he said to him, Where are you from, young man? And he said to him, From the sons of Israel, your brothers, and I have come here to work. And he said to him, Do you know the road to go to Media?

6 And he said to him, Yes, I have often been there and am experienced and know all the roads; many times I went to Media and lodged with Gabael our brother who lives in Rhagoi of Media, and the journey from Ecbatana to Rhaga is two appointed days; for they lie in the mountain.

7 And he said to him, Wait for me, young man, until I go in and inform my father; for I need you to walk with me, and I will give you your wage.

8 And he said to him, Behold, I am waiting; only do not delay.

9 And Tobias went in and informed Tobith his father and said to him, Behold, I have found a man of our brothers, the sons of Israel. And he said to him, Call the man for me, so that I may learn what his race is and from what tribe he is, and whether he is trustworthy to go with you, child.

10 And Tobias went out and called him and said to him, Young man, my father calls you. And he came in to him, and Tobith greeted him first. And he said to him, May much rejoicing come to you. And answering Tobith said to him, What rejoicing do I still have? And I am a man disabled in my eyes and do not see the light of heaven, but lie in darkness like the dead who no longer behold the light; living, I am among the dead; I hear the voice of people and do not see them. And he said to him, Take courage; healing you is near with God; take courage. And Tobith said to him, Tobias my son wants to go to Media; will you be able to go with him and bring him? And I will give you your wage, brother. And he said to him, I will be able to go with him, and I know all the roads, and I often went away to Media and passed through all its plains, and I know its mountains and all its roads.

11 And he said to him, Brother, of what family are you and from what tribe? Inform me, brother.

12 And he said, What need have you of a tribe? And he said to him, I wish to know truly whose you are, brother, and what your name is.

13 And he said to him, I am Azarias, of Ananias the great, of your brothers.

14 And he said to him, May you come in health and safety, brother; and do not be embittered against me, brother, because I wished to know the truth and your family. And you happen to be a brother, and you are from a fine and good lineage; I knew Ananias and Nathan, the two sons of Seme[l]ias the great, and they went with me to Jerusalem and worshiped with me there and did not go astray. Your brothers are good men; you are from a good root, and may you come rejoicing.

15 And he said to him, I give you a wage of a drachma a day and your necessities, just as for my son;

16 and go with my son, and I will add still more to your wage.

17 And he said to him, I will go with him; and do not fear; we will depart in health and return to you in health, because the road is secure. And he said to him, May a blessing come to you, brother. And he called his son and said to him, Child, prepare the things for the road and go out with your brother, and may the God in heaven preserve you there and restore you to me in health, and may his angel accompany you with safety, child. And he went out to travel his road and kissed his father and mother, and Tobith said to him, Go in health. –

18 And his mother wept and said to Tobith, Why is it that you sent my child away? Is he not the staff of our hand, and does he not come in and go out before us?

19 May silver not overtake silver, but may it become the offscouring of our child.

20 As living has been given to us by the Lord, this is sufficient for us.

21 And he said to her, Do not be concerned; our child will go in health and come to us in health, and your eyes will see on the day when he comes to you in health;

22 do not be concerned, do not fear about them, sister; for a good angel will go with him, and his road will prosper, and he will return in health.

23 And she ceased weeping.

Chapter 6

1 And the child went out, and the angel with him, and the dog went out with him and traveled with them; and both traveled, and one night came upon them, and they lodged by the Tigris river.

2 And the child went down into the Tigris river to wash his feet, and a great fish leaped up from the water and wanted to swallow the boy's foot, and he cried out.

3 And the angel said to the boy, Take hold and gain control of the fish. And the boy took hold of the fish and brought it up onto the earth.

4 And the angel said to him, Split open the fish and take out its gall and heart and liver, and put them aside with you, and throw out the entrails; for its gall and heart and liver are useful as medicine.

5 And the boy split open the fish and gathered the gall and heart and liver, and roasted some of the fish and ate and left some of it salted. –

6 And both traveled together until they drew near to Media.

7 And then the boy asked the angel and said to him, Azarias, brother, what medicine is in the fish's heart and liver and in the gall?

8 And he said to him, The fish's heart and liver, burn them to make smoke before a man or woman who has an encounter with a demon or evil spirit, and every encounter will flee from him, and they will certainly not remain with him forever;

9 and the gall, to anoint a person's eyes upon which white films have come up, to blow upon them, upon the white films, and they become healthy.

10 And when he entered Media and was already drawing near to Ecbatana,

11 Raphael says to the boy, Tobias, brother. And he said to him, Here I am. And he said to him, We must lodge at Ragouel's this night, and the man is your relative, and he has a daughter whose name is Sarra;

12 and he has neither a male son nor a daughter except Sarra alone, and you are nearest to her before all people to inherit her, and you have the right to inherit the possessions of her father; and the girl is prudent and courageous and very beautiful, and her father is good.

13 And he said, You have the right to take her; and listen to me, brother, and I will speak to her father about the girl this night, so that we may take her for you as a bride; and when we return from Rhagoi, we will make her wedding. And I know that Ragouel will certainly not be able to withhold her from you or betroth her to another, that he will incur death according to the judgment of the book of Moses, because he knows that the inheritance falls to you to take his daughter before every man. And now listen to me, brother, and we will speak about the girl this night and betroth her to you; and when we return from Rhagoi, we will take her and lead her away with us to your house.

14 Then answering Tobias said to Raphael, Azarias, brother, I heard that she has already been given to seven men, and they died in their bridal chambers at night, whenever they went in to her, and they died. And I heard them saying that a demon kills them.

15 And now I fear — because it does not wrong her, but whoever wants to approach her, it kills him; I am my father's only child — lest I die and bring down my father's and my mother's life with anguish over me into their grave; and they have no other son to bury them.

16 And he says to him, Do you not remember your father's commands, that he commanded you to take a wife from your father's house? And now listen to me, brother, and do not be concerned about this demon, and take her; and I know that this night she will be given to you as a wife.

17 And when you enter the bridal chamber, take some of the fish's liver and the heart, and place them upon the ashes of the incense, and the odor will go forth, and the demon will smell it and flee and will certainly no longer appear about her for the whole age.

18 And when you are about to be with her, first both rise and pray and beseech the Lord of heaven, that mercy and salvation may come upon you; and do not fear, for she has been allotted to you before the age, and you will save her, and she will go with you, and I suppose that you will have children from her, and they will be as brothers to you; do not be concerned.

19 And when Tobias heard Raphael's words and that she was a sister to him from the seed of his father's house, he loved her greatly, and his heart was joined to her.

Chapter 7

1 And when he entered Ecbatana, he says to him, Azarias, brother, lead me straight to Ragouel our brother. And he led him to Ragouel's house, and they found him sitting beside the door of the courtyard and greeted him first, and he said to them, Much greeting, brothers, and you have come well, in health. And he brought them into his house.

2 And he said to Edna his wife, How like Tobei my brother this young man is.

3 And Edna asked them and said to them, Where are you from, brothers? And they said to her, We are from the sons of Nephthalim who were taken captive in Nineue.

4 And she said to them, Do you know Tobin our brother? And they said to her, We know him.

5 And she said to them, Is he in health? And they said to her, He is in health and lives; and Tobias said, He is my father.

6 And Ragouel leaped up and kissed him and wept and spoke and said to him, May a blessing come to you, child of a fine and good father; O miserable evils, that a righteous man who does acts of mercy was blinded. And falling upon the neck of Tobias his brother, he wept.

7 And Edna his wife wept for him, and Sarra their daughter also wept.

8 And he slaughtered a ram from the sheep and welcomed them eagerly.

9 And when they had bathed and washed and reclined to dine, Tobias said to Raphael, Azarias, brother, tell Ragouel to give me Sarra my sister.

10 And Ragouel heard the word and said to the child, Eat and drink and be merry this night; for there is no man to whom it falls to take Sarra my daughter except you, brother, and likewise I have no authority to give her to another man except you, because you are nearest to me; and indeed I will inform you of the truth, child.

11 I gave her to seven men of our brothers, and all died at night whenever they went in to her. And now, child, eat and drink, and the Lord will act among you.

12 And Tobias said, I will certainly not eat from here or drink until you settle the things concerning me. And Ragouel said to him, I do so, and she is given to you according to the judgment of the book of Moses, and from heaven it has been judged that she be given to you; take your sister. From now you are her brother and she is your sister; she has been given to you from today and forever; and the Lord of heaven will prosper you, child, this night, and may he bring mercy and peace upon you.

13 And Ragouel called Sarra his daughter, and she came to him, and taking her hand he handed her over to him and said, Take her according to the law and according to the judgment written in the book of Moses, to give you the wife; have her and lead her away to your father in health; and may the God of heaven prosper peace for you.

14 And he called her mother; and he said to bring a document and wrote a written agreement of a document of living together, and how he gives her to him as a wife according to the judgment of the law of Moses. After that they began to eat and drink.

15 And Ragouel called Edna his wife and said to her, Sister, prepare the other chamber and bring her in there.

16 And she went and spread bedding in the chamber, as he said to her, and brought her there and wept over her and wiped away the tears and said to her,

17 Take courage, daughter; may the Lord of heaven give you joy in place of your grief; take courage, daughter. And she went out.

Chapter 8

1 And when they finished eating and drinking, they wished to sleep. And they led the young man away and brought him into the chamber.

2 And Tobias remembered Raphael's words and took the fish's liver and heart out of the bag which he had, and placed them upon the ashes of the incense.

3 And the odor of the fish hindered, and the demon ran away up into the parts of Egypt, and Raphael went and fettered him there and bound him immediately.

4 And they went out and shut the door of the chamber. And Tobias rose from the bed and said to her, Sister, rise; let us pray and beseech our Lord to bring mercy and salvation upon us.

5 And she rose, and they began to pray and beseech that salvation might come to them, and he began to say, Blessed are you, the God of our fathers, and blessed is your name unto all the ages of the generation; let the heavens and all your creation bless you unto all the ages.

6 You made Adam and made for him a helper, a support, Eua his wife, and from both came the seed of mankind; and you said, It is not good for the man to be alone; let us make him a helper like him.

7 And now I take this sister of mine, not because of fornication, but in truth; command that mercy be shown to me and her, and that we grow old together.

8 And they said with one another, Amen, amen.

9 And they slept that night.

10 And Ragouel rose and called the household servants with him, and they went away and dug a grave; for he said, Perhaps he will die and we will become a laughingstock and a reproach.

11 And when they finished digging the grave, Ragouel came into the house and called his wife

12 and said, Send one of the maidservants, and let her enter and see whether he lives; and if he has died, that we may bury him, that no one may know.

13 And they sent the maidservant and lit the lamp and opened the door, and she entered and found them sleeping and slumbering together.

14 And the maidservant went out and informed them that he lives and there is no evil.

15 And they blessed the God of heaven and said, Blessed are you, God, with every pure blessing; let them bless you unto all the ages.

16 And blessed are you because you have gladdened me, and it did not happen as I suspected, but according to your great mercy you acted with us.

17 And blessed are you because you showed mercy to two only children; bring them mercy and salvation, Master, and bring their life to completion with gladness and mercy.

18 Then he told his household servants to fill in the grave before dawn came.

19 And he told his wife to make many breads; and going to the herd he brought two oxen and four rams and said to finish them, and they began to prepare.

20 And he called Tobias and said to him, For fourteen days you will certainly not move from here, but will remain here eating and drinking with me, and you will gladden the soul of my daughter who has been in anguish;

21 and of all that belongs to me, take half from here and go in health to your father; and the other half, when both I and my wife die, is yours. Take courage, child; I am your father and Edna your mother, and we are with you and your sister from now forever; take courage, child.

Chapter 9

1 Then Tobias called Raphael and said to him,

2 Azarias, brother, take with you four household servants and two camels, and go to Rhaga and come to Gabael and give him the handwritten document and receive the silver and take him with you to the wedding;

34 for you know that my father will be counting the days, and if I delay one day, I will grieve him greatly; and you see what Ragouel swore, and I cannot transgress his oath.

5 And Raphael and the four household servants and the two camels went to Rhaga of Media and lodged with Gabael; and he gave him his handwritten document and informed him about Tobios the son of Tobith, that he had taken a wife and that he calls him to the wedding. And rising he counted out to him the bags with the seals, and they put them together.

6 And they rose early together and came to the wedding. And they came into Ragouel's and found Tobias reclining, and he leaped up and greeted him and wept and blessed him and said to him, Fine and good one, of a fine and good man, righteous and merciful, may the Lord give you a blessing of heaven, and to your wife and your father and the mother of your wife; blessed is God, because I have seen Tobin my cousin, like him.

Chapter 10

1 And each day, day after day, Tobith calculated the days, in how many he would travel and in how many he would return; and when the days were completed and his son was not present,

2 he said, Perhaps he has been detained there? Or perhaps Gabael has died and no one gives him the silver?

3 And he began to grieve.

4 And Anna his wife says, My child has perished and is no longer among the living; and she began to weep and lament about her son, and said,

5 Woe to me, child, because I let you go, the light of my eyes.

6 And Tobith said to her, Be silent, do not be concerned, sister; he is in health; and indeed a distraction has come upon them there, and the man who went with him is trustworthy and one of our brothers; do not grieve about him, sister; he will soon be here.

7 And she said to him, Be silent toward me and do not mislead me; my child has perished. And springing out she watched the road by which her son had gone each day and was persuaded by no one, and when the sun set, she went in and lamented and wept the whole night and had no sleep.

8 And when the fourteen days of the wedding were completed, which Ragouel swore to make for his daughter, Tobias came in to him and said, Send me away, for I know that my father and mother do not believe that they will see me again; and now I ask you, father, to send me away and let me go to my father; I have already told you how I left him.

9 And Ragouel said to Tobias, Remain, child, remain with me, and I will send messengers to Tobin your father, and they will inform him about you. And he said to him, By no means; I ask you to send me away from here to my father.

10 And rising Ragouel handed over to Tobias Sarra his wife and half of everything that belonged to him, male servants and maidservants, oxen and sheep, donkeys and camels, clothing and silver and vessels;

11 and he sent them away in health and greeted him and said to him, Be in health, child, go in health; may the Lord of heaven prosper you and Sarra your wife, and may I see children of yours before I die.

12 And he said to Sarra his daughter, Go to your father-in-law, because from now they are your parents as those who begot you; walk into peace, daughter; may I hear a good report of you while I live. And bidding farewell he released them.

13 And Edna says to Tobias, Child and beloved brother, may the Lord restore you, and may I see children of yours while I live, and of Sarra my daughter, before I die; before the Lord I entrust my daughter to you as a deposit; do not grieve her all the days of your life; child, into peace; from now I am your mother and Sarra your sister; may we all prosper together all the days of our life. And she kissed both and sent them away in health.

14 And Tobias departed from Ragouel in health and rejoicing and blessing the Lord of heaven and earth, the king of all things, because he had prospered his road. And he said to him, It has prospered for you to honor them all the days of their life.

Chapter 11

1 And as they drew near to Kaserin, which is opposite Nineue, Raphael said,

2 You know how we left your father;

3 let us run ahead of your wife and prepare the house while they are coming.

4 And both traveled together, and he said to him, Take the gall at hand. And the dog went with them, from behind him and Tobias.

5 And Anna sat watching her son's road;

6 and she perceived him coming and said to his father, Behold, your son is coming, and the man who went with him.

7 And Raphael said to Tobias before he approached his father, I know that his eyes will be opened;

8 smear the fish's gall into his eyes, and the medicine will make them contract and peel the white films from his eyes, and your father will see again and see the light.

9 And [Anna] ran up and fell upon her son's neck and said to him, I have seen you, child; from now I will die. And she wept.

10 And Tobis rose and stumbled with his feet and went out through the door of the courtyard,

11 and Tobias walked toward him, and the fish's gall was in his hand, and he blew into his eyes and took hold of him and said, Take courage, father; and he applied the medicine upon him and administered it.

12 And he peeled it away with both his hands from the corners of his eyes.

13 And he fell upon his neck and wept and said to him, I have seen you, child, the light of my eyes.

14 And he said, Blessed is God, and blessed is his great name, and blessed are all his holy angels; may his great name be upon us, and blessed are all the angels unto all the ages; because he whipped me, and behold, I see Tobias my son.

15 And Tobias entered rejoicing and blessing God with his whole mouth, and Tobias showed his father that his road had prospered and that he had brought silver, and how he took Sarra the daughter of Ragouel as a wife, and that, behold, she is arriving and is close to the gate of Nineue.

16 And [Tobith] went out to meet his daughter-in-law, rejoicing and blessing God, toward the gate of Nineue; and those in Nineue saw him walking and crossing with all his strength and being led by the hand by no one, and marveled, and Tobith gave thanks before them that God had shown him mercy and had opened his eyes.

17 And Tobith approached Sarra, the wife of Tobias his son, and blessed her and said to her, May you enter in health, daughter, and blessed is your God who brought you to us, daughter; and blessed is your father, and blessed is Tobias my son, and blessed are you, daughter; enter your house in health, in blessing and joy; enter, daughter.

18 On this day there was joy for all the Judeans who were in Nineue.

19 And Achikar and Nabad his cousins came rejoicing to Tobin.

Chapter 12

1 And when the wedding was completed, Tobith called Tobias his son and said to him, Child, see to giving the wage to the man who went with you [and] adding to his wage.

2 And he said to him, Father, how much wage will I give him? I am not harmed by giving him half the possessions which he has brought with me.

3 He has brought me in health and healed my wife and brought the silver with me and healed you; how much more wage should I give him?

4 And Tobis said to him, He has the right, child, to take half of everything that he came having.

5 And he called him and said, Take half of everything that you came having as your wage, and go in health.

6 Then he called the two privately and said to them, Bless God and give thanks to him before all the living for the good things which he did with you, to bless and hymn his name; make the words of God known honorably to all people, and do not hesitate to give thanks to him.

7 It is good to hide a king's secret, but to uncover the works of God and acknowledge them honorably. Do good, and evil will not find you.

8 Prayer with truth and mercy with righteousness are good, rather than wealth with unrighteousness; it is good to do an act of mercy rather than store up gold.

9 Mercy delivers from death, and it cleanses every sin; those who do acts of mercy will be filled with life;

10 those who do sin and unrighteousness are enemies of their own soul.

11 I will make all the truth known to you and will certainly not hide any word from you; I have already informed you and said, It is good to hide a king's secret and to uncover the works of God gloriously.

12 And now, when you prayed, and Sarra, I brought the memorial of your prayer before the glory of the Lord; and when you buried the dead, likewise;

13 and when you did not hesitate to rise and leave your meal and went away and wrapped the dead man, then I have been sent to you to test you.

14 And at the same time God has sent me to heal [you] and Sarra your daughter-in-law.

15 I am Raphael, one of the seven angels who stand by and enter before the glory of the Lord.

16 And the two were troubled and fell upon their faces and were afraid.

17 And he said to them, Do not fear; peace to you; bless God for the whole age.

18 When I was with you, I was with you, not by my own favor, but by the will of God; bless him every day; hymn him.

19 And you beheld me, that I ate nothing, but a vision was being beheld by you.

20 And now bless the Lord upon the earth and give thanks to God. Behold, I ascend to the one who sent me. Write all these things that happened to you. And he ascended.

21 And they rose; and they could no longer see him.

22 And they blessed and hymned God and gave thanks to him for these great works of his, how an angel of God appeared to them.

Chapter 13

1 And he said,

2 Blessed is God who lives forever, and his kingdom, because he whips and shows mercy, brings down to Hades, lowest beneath the earth, and he brings up from the great destruction, and there is nothing that will escape his hand.

3 Give thanks to him, sons of Israel, before the nations, because he scattered you among them;

4 and there he showed you his greatness, and exalt him before every living being, because he is our Lord, and he is our God and he is our Father and he is God unto all the ages.

5 He will whip you for your unrighteous deeds and show mercy to all of you from all the nations, wherever you are scattered among them.

6 When you return to him with your whole heart and with your whole soul to do truth before him, then he will return to you and will certainly no longer hide his face from you.

7 And now behold what he did with you, and give thanks to him with your whole mouth; and bless the Lord of righteousness and exalt the king of the ages. –

11 And again your tent will be built for you with joy.

12 And may he gladden in you all the captives and love in you all the afflicted unto all the generations of the age.

13 A bright light will shine to all the ends of the earth; many nations from afar [will come to you], and inhabitants of all the remotest parts of the earth, toward your holy name and having their gifts in their hands for the king of heaven; generations of generations will give exultation in you, and the name of the chosen one unto the generations of the age.

14 Accursed are all who will speak a harsh word; accursed will be all who tear you down and pull down your walls, and all who overthrow your towers and burn your dwellings; and blessed forever will be all who fear you.

15 Then go and exult toward the sons of the righteous, because all will be gathered together and bless the Lord of the age. Blessed are those who love you, and blessed are those who will rejoice over your peace;

16 and blessed are all the people who will grieve over you, over all your scourges, because in you they will rejoice and see all your joy forever. My soul, bless the Lord, the great king.

17 Because Jerusalem will be built, his house in the city unto all the ages. I will be blessed if the remnant of my seed comes to see your glory and give thanks to the king of heaven. And the doors of Jerusalem will be built with sapphire and emerald, and all your walls with precious stone; the towers of Jerusalem will be built with gold, and their battlements with pure gold; the streets of Jerusalem will be paved with carbuncle and stone of Souphir.

18 And the doors of Jerusalem will speak songs of exultation, and all her houses will say, Alleluia, blessed is the God of Israel; and blessed ones will bless the holy name forever and beyond.

Chapter 14

1 And the words of Tobith's thanksgiving were completed.

2 And he died in peace, one hundred twelve years old, and was buried gloriously in Nineue. And he was sixty-two years old when he became disabled in his eyes, and after seeing again he lived amid good things and did acts of mercy; and he continued still to bless God and acknowledge the greatness of God.

3 And when he was dying, he called Tobias his son and commanded him, saying, Child, take your children away

4 and run away to Media, because I believe the word of God against Nineue, what Naoum spoke, that everything will happen and come upon Athour and Nineue, and everything the prophets of Israel whom God sent spoke will come to pass, and nothing will be diminished from all the words, and everything will happen in its times, and in Media there will be salvation rather than among the Assyrians and in Babylon; therefore I know and believe that everything God said will be completed and happen, and no word from the sayings will fall away; and all our brothers who dwell in the land of Israel will be scattered and taken captive from the good land, and all the land of Israel will be desolate, and Samaria and Jerusalem will be desolate, and the house of God in grief, and it will be burned for a time.

5 And again God will show them mercy, and God will return them to the land of Israel, and again they will build the house, and not like the first, until the time when the time of the seasons is fulfilled. And after these things all will return from their captivity and build Jerusalem honorably, and the house of God in it will be built, as the prophets of Israel spoke about it.

6 And all the nations in the whole earth, all will return and fear God truly, and all will abandon their idols, the false ones that lead them astray in their wandering, and bless the God of the age in righteousness.

7 All the sons of Israel who are saved in those days, remembering God in truth, will be gathered together and come to Jerusalem and dwell forever in the land of Abraam with security, and it will be handed over to them; and those who love God in truth will rejoice, and those who do sin and unrighteousness will vanish from all the earth.

89 And now, children, I command you: serve God in truth and do what is pleasing before him, and it will be enjoined upon your children to do righteousness and mercy, and that they remember God and bless his name at every time in truth and with their whole strength. And now you, child, go out from Nineue and do not remain here; on whatever day you bury your mother with me, on that very day do not lodge within its borders; for I see that much unrighteousness is in it, and much deceit is carried out in it, and they are not ashamed.

10 See, child, all that Nadab did to Achikar who raised him; was he not brought down living into the earth? And God repaid the dishonor before his face, and Achikar came out into the light, and Nadab entered the darkness of the age, because he sought to kill Achikar; by doing an act of mercy he came out from the snare of death which Nadab set for him, and Nadab fell into the snare of death, and it destroyed him.

11 And now, children, see what mercy does, and what unrighteousness does, that it kills; and behold, my soul is failing. – And they placed him upon the bed, and he died; and he was buried gloriously.

12 And when his mother died, Tobias buried her with his father. And he and his wife departed to Media and dwelt in Ecbatana with Ragouel his father-in-law.

13 And he supported them honorably in old age and buried them in Ecbatana of Media and inherited the household of Ragouel and of Tobith his father.

14 And he died gloriously, one hundred seventeen years old.

15 And before he died he saw and heard the destruction of Nineue, and saw its captivity being led into Media, which Achiacharos the king of Media took captive, and he blessed God in all that he did against the sons of Nineue and Athouria; before dying he rejoiced over Nineue and blessed the Lord God unto the ages of the ages.

1 Maccabees

Chapter 1

1 And it happened after Alexandros, the son of Philippos, the Macedonian, who went out from the land of Chettiim, struck Dareios king of the Persians and Medes and reigned in his place, previously over Greece.

2 And he established many wars and took hold of fortifications and slaughtered kings of the earth;

3 and he passed through to the ends of the earth and took spoils of a multitude of nations. And the earth was quiet before him, and he was exalted, and his heart was lifted up.

4 And he gathered an exceedingly strong army and ruled countries of nations and rulers, and they became tributary to him.

5 And after these things he fell upon his bed and knew that he was dying.

6 And he called his glorious servants, those brought up with him from youth, and divided his kingdom among them while he was still living.

7 And Alexandros reigned twelve years and died.

8 And his servants took power, each in his own place.

9 And they all put on diadems after he died, and their sons after them for many years, and they multiplied evils in the earth.

10 And from them came out a sinful root, Antiochos Epiphanes, son of King Antiochos, who was a hostage in Rome; and he reigned in the one hundred thirty-seventh year of the kingdom of the Greeks.

11 In those days lawless sons went out from Israel and persuaded many, saying, Let us go and make a covenant with the nations around us, because since we separated from them many evils have found us.

12 And the word seemed good in their eyes,

13 and some of the people eagerly went to the king, and he gave them authority to do the ordinances of the nations.

14 And they built a gymnasium in Jerusalem according to the customs of the nations

15 and made foreskins for themselves and departed from the holy covenant and were yoked to the nations and sold themselves to do evil.

16 And the kingdom was established before Antiochos, and he undertook to reign over the land of Egypt, so that he might reign over the two kingdoms.

17 And he entered Egypt with a heavy multitude, with chariots and elephants and horsemen and a great fleet,

18 and established war against Ptolemaios king of Egypt; and Ptolemaios was put to flight before him and fled, and many fell wounded.

19 And they took hold of the fortified cities in the land of Egypt, and he took the spoils of the land of Egypt.

20 And Antiochos returned after striking Egypt in the one hundred forty-third year, and went up against Israel and went up to Jerusalem with a heavy multitude.

21 And he entered the sanctuary in arrogance and took the golden altar and the lampstand of light and all its vessels

22 and the table of the presentation and the libation vessels and the bowls and the golden censers and the curtain and the crowns and the golden ornament on the face of the temple, and stripped everything;

23 and he took the silver and the gold and the desirable vessels, and took the hidden treasures which he found;

24 and taking everything he departed to his land. And he committed murder and spoke great arrogance.

25 And great mourning came upon Israel in every place of theirs.

26 And rulers and elders groaned, virgins and young men grew weak, and the beauty of the women was altered.

27 Every bridegroom took up lamentation, and she who sat in the bridal chamber mourned.

28 And the earth was shaken over its inhabitants, and the whole house of Iakob put on shame.

29 After two years of days the king sent a ruler of tribute collection to the cities of Iouda, and he came to Jerusalem with a heavy multitude.

30 And he spoke peaceful words to them in deceit, and they trusted him. And he fell upon the city suddenly and struck it with a great blow and destroyed many people from Israel.

31 And he took the spoils of the city and burned it with fire and tore down its houses and the walls around it.

32 And they took the women and children captive, and took possession of the livestock.

33 And they built up the city of Dauid with a great and strong wall, with strong towers, and it became a citadel for them.

34 And they placed there a sinful nation, lawless men, and they strengthened themselves in it.

35 And they stored weapons and food, and gathering the spoils of Jerusalem they put them away there and became a great snare.

36 And it became an ambush against the sanctuary and an evil adversary against Israel continually.

37 And they poured out innocent blood around the sanctuary and defiled the sanctuary.

38 And the inhabitants of Jerusalem fled because of them, and it became a dwelling of strangers; and it became strange to its offspring, and its children abandoned it.

39 Its sanctuary was laid waste like a wilderness, its feasts were turned into mourning, its sabbaths into reproach, its honor into contempt.

40 In proportion to its glory its dishonor was multiplied, and its height was turned into mourning.

41 And the king wrote to his whole kingdom that all should be one people

42 and each abandon his customs. And all the nations accepted according to the king's word.

43 And many from Israel approved his worship and sacrificed to the idols and profaned the sabbath.

44 And the king sent documents by the hand of messengers to Jerusalem and the cities of Iouda, to walk after customs foreign to the land

45 and to prevent burnt offerings and sacrifice and libation from the sanctuary, and to profane sabbaths and feasts

46 and defile the sanctuary and holy ones,

47 to build altars and sacred precincts and shrines of idols, and to sacrifice swine and unclean livestock,

48 and to leave their sons uncircumcised, to make their souls abominable with everything unclean and with profanation,

49 so as to forget the law and alter all the ordinances;

50 and whoever does not act according to the king's word will die.

51 According to all these words he wrote to his whole kingdom and made overseers over all the people and commanded the cities of Iouda to sacrifice, city by city.

52 And many from the people gathered to them, everyone who abandoned the law, and they did evils in the land

53 and placed Israel in hiding, in every refuge of theirs.

54 And on the fifteenth day of Chaseleu in the one hundred forty-fifth year he built an abomination of desolation upon the altar. And in the cities of Iouda around it they built altars;

55 and at the doors of the houses and in the streets they burned incense.

56 And the books of the law which they found they tore apart and burned with fire.

57 And wherever a book of the covenant was found with anyone, and if anyone approved the law, the king's decree put him to death.

58 In their strength they acted against Israel, against those found in the cities each and every month.

59 And on the twenty-fifth of the month, sacrificing upon the altar which was upon the altar of sacrifice.

60 And the women who had circumcised their children they put to death according to the ordinance

61 and hung the infants from their necks, and their households and those who had circumcised them.

62 And many in Israel grew strong and fortified themselves within themselves not to eat unclean things

63 and accepted death, so that they might not be defiled by the foods or profane the holy covenant, and they died.

64 And exceedingly great wrath came upon Israel.

Chapter 2

1 In those days Mattathias son of Ioannes, of Symeon, a priest of the sons of Ioarib, arose from Jerusalem and settled in Modein.

2 And he had five sons, Ioannes called Gaddi,

3 Simon called Thassi,

4 Ioudas called Makkabaios,

5 Eleazar called Auaran, Ionathes called Apphous.

6 And he saw the blasphemies happening in Iouda and Jerusalem

7 and said, Alas for me, why was I born for this, to see the crushing of my people and the crushing of the holy city, and to sit there when it was given into the hand of enemies, the sanctuary into the hand of strangers?

8 Its temple became like a man without glory,

9 the vessels of its glory were led away captive, its infants were killed in its streets, its young men by an enemy's sword.

10 What nation has not inherited royal possessions and taken hold of its spoils?

11 All its adornment was removed; instead of free it became a slave.

12 And behold, our holy things and our beauty and our glory were laid waste, and the nations profaned them.

13 Why is there still life for us?

14 And Mattathias and his sons tore their garments and put on sackcloth and mourned exceedingly.

15 And those from the king who compelled apostasy came to the city of Modein, so that they might sacrifice.

16 And many from Israel approached them; and Mattathias and his sons were gathered.

17 And those from the king answered and spoke to Mattathias, saying, You are a ruler and glorious and great in this city, and supported by sons and brothers;

18 now approach first and do the king's ordinance, as all the nations and the men of Iouda and those left in Jerusalem have done, and you and your sons will be among the king's friends, and you and your sons will be glorified with silver and gold and many gifts.

19 And Mattathias answered and said with a great voice, If all the nations in the house of the king's kingdom obey him, each to depart from the worship of his fathers, and have chosen his commands,

20 yet I and my sons and my brothers will walk in the covenant of our fathers;

21 far be it from us to abandon law and ordinances;

22 we will not obey the king's words, to depart from our worship to the right or left.

23 And as he ceased speaking these words, a Judean man approached in the eyes of all to sacrifice upon the altar in Modein according to the king's ordinance.

24 And Mattathias saw and was zealous, and his kidneys trembled, and he brought up wrath according to the judgment, and running he slaughtered him upon the altar;

25 and the king's man who compelled sacrifice he killed at that time, and tore down the altar.

26 And he was zealous for the law, as Phinees did to Zambri son of Salom.

27 And Mattathias cried out in the city with a great voice, saying, Let everyone zealous for the law and upholding the covenant come out after me.

28 And he and his sons fled into the mountains and abandoned all they had in the city.

29 Then many seeking righteousness and judgment went down into the wilderness to settle there,

30 they and their sons and their wives and their livestock, because the evils grew harsh against them.

31 And it was reported to the king's men and the armies which were in Jerusalem, the city of Dauid, that men who had rejected the king's command had gone down into the hiding places in the wilderness.

32 And many ran after them and overtook them and encamped against them and established war against them on the day of the sabbaths

33 and said to them, Until now; come out and act according to the king's word, and you will live.

34 And they said, We will not come out or do the king's word, to profane the day of the sabbaths.

35 And they hastened war against them.

36 And they did not answer them or throw a stone at them or block up the hiding places,

37 saying, Let us all die in our integrity; heaven and earth bear witness concerning us that you destroy us without judgment.

38 And they rose against them in war on the sabbaths, and they and their wives and their children and their livestock died, up to a thousand human souls.

39 And Mattathias and his friends learned of it and mourned exceedingly over them.

40 And a man said to his neighbor, If we all do as our brothers did and do not fight against the nations for our soul and our ordinances, now they will more quickly destroy us from the earth.

41 And they resolved on that day, saying, Every person who comes against us for war on the day of the sabbaths, let us fight against him, and we will certainly not all die as our brothers died in the hiding places.

42 Then an assembly of Asidaians gathered to them, strong in power from Israel, everyone who willingly offered himself for the law;

43 and all who fled from the evils joined them and became a support for them.

44 And they established an army and struck sinners in their anger and lawless men in their wrath; and the rest fled to the nations to be saved.

45 And Mattathias and his friends went around and tore down the altars

46 and circumcised the uncircumcised boys, all whom they found within the borders of Israel, by force,

47 and pursued the sons of arrogance, and the work prospered in their hand;

48 and they rescued the law from the hand of the nations and the kings, and did not give a horn to the sinner.

49 And the days for Mattathias to die drew near, and he said to his sons, Now arrogance and rebuke have been established, and a time of overthrow and wrath of anger.

50 Now, children, be zealous for the law and give your souls for the covenant of our fathers,

51 and remember the works of the fathers which they did in their generations, and receive great glory and an everlasting name.

52 Was not Abraam found faithful in trial, and was it not reckoned to him as righteousness?

53 Ioseph in the time of his distress kept the command and became lord of Egypt.

54 Phinees our father, in being zealous with zeal, received a covenant of everlasting priesthood.

55 Iesous, in fulfilling the word, became a judge in Israel.

56 Chaleb, in bearing witness in the assembly, received an inheritance of land.

57 Dauid, in his mercy, inherited a throne of kingship unto ages.

58 Elias, in being zealous with zeal for the law, was taken up into heaven.

59 Ananias, Azarias, Misael believed and were saved from the flame.

60 Daniel, in his integrity, was delivered from the mouth of lions.

61 And thus consider generation by generation, that all who hope in him will not grow weak.

62 And do not fear the words of a sinful man, because his glory is for dung and worms;

63 today he will be exalted and tomorrow he will certainly not be found, because he returned to his dust, and his reasoning will perish.

64 Children, be courageous and strong in the law, because in it you will be glorified.

65 And behold, Symeon your brother, I know that he is a man of counsel; listen to him all the days; he will be your father.

66 And Ioudas Makkabaios is strong in power from his youth; he will be your commander of the army and will fight the war of peoples.

67 And you will bring to yourselves all the doers of the law, and avenge the vengeance of your people;

68 repay a repayment to the nations, and attend to the ordinance of the law. –

69 And he blessed them; and was added to his fathers.

70 And he died in the one hundred forty-sixth year and was buried in the tombs of his fathers in Modein, and all Israel lamented him with a great lamentation.

Chapter 3

1 And Ioudas his son, called Makkabaios, arose in his place.

2 And all his brothers and all who had joined his father helped him, and fought the war of Israel with gladness.

3 And he enlarged glory for his people and put on a breastplate like a giant and girded on his war equipment and established wars, protecting the army with a sword.

4 And he was like a lion in his works, and like a young lion roaring for prey.

5 And he pursued lawless men, searching them out, and burned those who troubled his people.

6 And lawless men shrank back from fear of him, and all the workers of lawlessness were troubled, and salvation prospered in his hand.

7 And he embittered many kings and gladdened Iakob with his works, and his memorial is for a blessing forever.

8 And he passed through the cities of Iouda and destroyed the ungodly out of it and turned wrath away from Israel

9 and was named to the end of the earth and gathered those who were perishing.

10 And Apollonios gathered nations and a great army from Samaria to fight against Israel.

11 And Ioudas learned of it and went out to meet him and struck him and killed him; and many fell wounded, and the remainder fled.

12 And they took their spoils, and Ioudas took the sword of Apollonios and fought with it all the days.

13 And Seron, the commander of the army of Syria, heard that Ioudas had gathered a gathering and an assembly of faithful men with him, who went out to war,

14 and he said, I will make a name for myself and be glorified in the kingdom, and I will fight Ioudas and those with him who despise the king's word.

15 And he proceeded, and a strong army of ungodly men went up with him to help him execute vengeance upon the sons of Israel.

16 And he drew near as far as the ascent of Baithoron, and Ioudas went out to meet him with few men.

17 And when they saw the army coming to meet them, they said to Ioudas, How will we be able, being few, to fight against so strong a multitude? And we are exhausted, having eaten nothing today.

18 And Ioudas said, It is easy for many to be shut into the hands of few, and there is no difference before heaven in saving by many or by few;

19 because victory in war is not in the multitude of an army, but strength is from heaven.

20 They come against us with a multitude of insolence and lawlessness, to remove us and our wives and our children, to despoil us,

21 but we fight for our souls and our customs.

22 And he will crush them before our face, but do not fear them.

23 And when he ceased speaking, he leaped upon them suddenly, and Seron and his army were crushed before him.

24 And they pursued him on the descent of Baithoron as far as the plain; and about eight hundred men of them fell, and the rest fled to the land of Phylistiim.

25 And the fear of Ioudas and his brothers began, and terror fell upon the nations around them;

26 and his name reached as far as the king, and the nations recounted the battles of Ioudas.

27 And when King Antiochos heard these words, he was angered with wrath and sent and gathered all the armies of his kingdom, an exceedingly strong army.

28 And he opened his treasury and gave pay to the armies for a year and commanded them to be ready for every need.

29 And he saw that the silver had run out from the treasuries, and the tributes of the country were few because of the dissension and blow which he had brought about in the land, to remove the customs which had been from the earliest days,

30 and he feared that he might not have, as once and twice before, for the expenses and the gifts which he formerly gave with a lavish hand, and he had surpassed the kings before him,

31 and he was exceedingly perplexed in his soul and resolved to go to Persia and take the tributes of the countries and gather much silver.

32 And he left Lysias, a glorious man and of royal lineage, over the king's affairs from the Euphrates river as far as the borders of Egypt,

33 and to rear Antiochos his son until he returned;

34 and he handed over to him half the armies and the elephants and commanded him concerning everything he wished, and concerning the inhabitants of Judaea and Jerusalem,

35 to send an army against them to wipe out and remove the strength of Israel and the remnant of Jerusalem, and remove their memorial from the place,

36 and settle sons of foreigners in all their borders and allot their land as an inheritance.

37 And the king took the remaining half of the armies and departed from Antioch, from the city of his kingdom, in the one hundred forty-seventh year, and crossed the Euphrates river and traveled through the upper countries.

38 And Lysias chose Ptolemaios son of Dorymenes and Nikanor and Gorgias, powerful men among the king's friends,

39 and sent with them forty thousand men and seven thousand cavalry to come into the land of Iouda and destroy it according to the king's word.

40 And he departed with all their army, and they came and encamped near Ammaous in the level land.

41 And the merchants of the country heard their name and took exceedingly much silver and gold and fetters and came into the camp to take the sons of Israel as slaves. And an army of Syria and the land of foreigners joined them.

42 And Ioudas and his brothers saw that the evils had multiplied and the armies were encamping within their borders, and they learned the king's words which he commanded to be done to the people for destruction and annihilation,

43 and each said to his neighbor, Let us raise up the fallen state of our people, and fight for our people and the holy things.

44 And the assembly was gathered to be ready for war and to pray and ask for mercy and compassion.

45 And Jerusalem was uninhabited like a wilderness; there was no one coming in and going out from its offspring, and the sanctuary was being trampled, and sons of foreigners were in the citadel, a lodging for the nations; and delight was removed from Iakob, and flute and lyre ceased.

46 And they gathered and came to Massepha opposite Jerusalem, because formerly there was a place of prayer in Massepha for Israel.

47 And they fasted on that day and put on sackcloth and ashes upon their head and tore their garments.

48 And they spread out the book of the law concerning which the nations searched out the likenesses of their idols.

49 And they brought the garments of the priesthood and the first produce and the tithes, and brought forward the Nazirites who had fulfilled their days,

50 and cried with a voice to heaven, saying, What should we do with these, and where should we lead them away,

51 when your holy things have been trampled and profaned and your priests are in mourning and humiliation?

52 And behold, the nations have gathered against us to remove us; you know what they devise against us.

53 How will we be able to stand before their face unless you help us?

54 And they sounded the trumpets and cried with a great voice.

55 And after this Ioudas appointed leaders of the people, commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds and commanders of fifties and commanders of tens.

56 And he told those building houses and betrothing wives and planting vineyards and the cowardly to return, each to his house, according to the law.

57 And the army departed, and they encamped south of Ammaous.

58 And Ioudas said, Gird yourselves and become mighty sons, and be ready for morning to fight against these nations gathered against us to remove us and our holy things;

59 because it is better for us to die in war than to look upon the evils of our nation and the holy things.

60 And as the will in heaven may be, so he will do.

Chapter 4

1 And Gorgias took five thousand men and a thousand chosen cavalry, and the army departed by night

2 to fall upon the camp of the Judeans and strike them suddenly; and sons of the citadel were his guides.

3 And Ioudas heard and departed, he and the mighty men, to strike the king's army in Ammaous,

4 while the armies were still scattered away from the camp.

5 And Gorgias came into Ioudas's camp by night and found no one; and he sought them in the mountains, because he said, These men are fleeing from us.

6 And at daybreak Ioudas appeared in the plain with three thousand men; except they did not have coverings and swords as they wished.

7 And they saw an army of nations, strong and wearing breastplates, and cavalry surrounding it, and these were trained in war.

8 And Ioudas said to the men with him, Do not fear their multitude or be cowardly at their assault;

9 remember how our fathers were saved in the Red Sea when Pharao pursued them with an army;

10 and now let us cry to heaven, whether he will favor us and remember the covenant of the fathers and crush this army before our face today,

11 and all the nations will know that there is one who redeems and saves Israel.

12 And the foreigners lifted their eyes and saw them coming opposite them

13 and went out of the camp to war; and those with Ioudas sounded the trumpet

14 and joined battle, and the nations were crushed and fled into the plain,

15 and all those in the rear fell by the sword. And they pursued them as far as Gazera and as far as the plains of Idumaea and Azotos and Iamneia, and about three thousand men of them fell.

16 And Ioudas and the army returned from pursuing after them

17 and he said to the people, Do not desire the spoils, because war is opposite us,

18 and Gorgias and the army are in the mountain near us; but stand now before our enemies and fight them, and after these things take the spoils with confidence.

19 While Ioudas was still completing these words, a certain part appeared looking out from the mountain;

20 and it saw that they had been routed and that they were burning the camp; for the smoke that was seen made what had happened evident.

21 And seeing these things they became exceedingly cowardly; and seeing also Ioudas's army in the plain ready for battle,

22 they all fled into the land of foreigners.

23 And Ioudas returned to the plundering of the camp, and they took much gold and silver and blue cloth and sea-purple and great wealth.

24 And returning they hymned and blessed toward heaven, because it is good, because his mercy is forever.

25 And great salvation came to Israel on that day.

26 And all the foreigners who were preserved came and reported to Lysias everything that had happened.

27 And hearing it he was confounded and disheartened, because such things had happened to Israel as he did not wish, and it did not turn out as the king had commanded him.

28 And in the coming year he assembled sixty thousand chosen men and five thousand cavalry to make war upon them.

29 And they came into Idumaea and encamped in Baithsoura, and Ioudas met them with ten thousand men.

30 And he saw the strong army and prayed and said, Blessed are you, the savior of Israel, who crushed the assault of the mighty man by the hand of your servant Dauid, and you handed over the army of foreigners into the hands of Ionathes son of Saoul and the bearer of his equipment;

31 thus shut this army into the hand of your people Israel, and let them be ashamed of their army and their cavalry;

32 give them cowardice and melt the boldness of their strength, and let them be shaken at their crushing;

33 cast them down by the sword of those who love you, and let all who know your name praise you with hymns.

34 And they engaged one another, and about five thousand men fell from Lysias's army, and they fell opposite them.

35 And Lysias, seeing the rout of his own formation and the courage that had arisen in Ioudas's, and how they were ready either to live or to die nobly, departed to Antioch and recruited more mercenaries to come again into Judaea.

36 And Ioudas and his brothers said, Behold, our enemies have been crushed; let us go up to cleanse the holy things and dedicate them.

37 And the whole army gathered, and they went up to Mount Sion.

38 And they saw the sanctuary laid waste and the altar profaned and the doors burned down, and plants grown in the courts as in a forest or as on one of the mountains, and the chambers torn down.

39 And they tore their garments and lamented with a great lamentation and put on ashes

40 and fell face down upon the earth and sounded the signaling trumpets and cried to heaven.

41 Then Ioudas commanded men to fight those in the citadel until he cleansed the holy things.

42 And he chose blameless priests who desired the law,

43 and they cleansed the holy things and took the stones of defilement to an unclean place.

44 And they deliberated concerning the profaned altar of burnt offering, what they should do with it;

45 and good counsel came to them to tear it down, lest it become a reproach to them because the nations had defiled it; and they tore down the altar

46 and put away the stones on the mountain of the house in a suitable place until a prophet came to answer concerning them.

47 And they took whole stones according to the law and built a new altar like the former one.

48 And they built the holy things and the interior of the house and sanctified the courts

49 and made new holy vessels and brought the lampstand and the altar of incense and the table into the temple.

50 And they burned incense upon the altar and kindled the lamps upon the lampstand, and they shone in the temple.

51 And they placed breads upon the table and spread out the curtains. And they completed all the works which they did.

52 And they rose early in the morning on the twenty-fifth of the ninth month [this is the month Chaseleu] of the one hundred forty-eighth year

53 and offered sacrifice according to the law upon the new altar of burnt offerings which they made.

54 At the season and on the day on which the nations had profaned it, on that day it was dedicated with songs and harps and lyres and cymbals.

55 And all the people fell upon their faces and worshiped and blessed toward heaven the one who had prospered them.

56 And they celebrated the dedication of the altar for eight days and offered burnt offerings with gladness and sacrificed a sacrifice of salvation and praise.

57 And they adorned the face of the temple with golden crowns and small shields and dedicated the gates and the chambers and fitted them with doors.

58 And exceedingly great gladness came among the people, and the reproach of the nations was turned away.

59 And Ioudas and his brothers and the whole assembly of Israel established that the days of the dedication of the altar should be observed at their seasons, year by year, for eight days from the twenty-fifth of the month Chaseleu, with gladness and joy.

60 And at that time they built high walls and strong towers around Mount Sion, lest the nations come and trample them as they did formerly.

61 And he stationed an army there to guard it and fortified it to guard Baithsoura, so that the people might have a fortification before Idumaea.

Chapter 5

1 And it happened when the surrounding nations heard that the altar had been built and the sanctuary dedicated as formerly, they were exceedingly angry

2 and resolved to remove the race of Iakob, those among them, and began to put to death among the people and to remove them.

3 And Ioudas fought against the sons of Esau in Idumaea, Akrabattene, because they besieged Israel, and he struck them with a great blow and subdued them and took their spoils.

4 And he remembered the wickedness of the sons of Baian, who were a snare and a stumbling block to the people by ambushing them on the roads;

5 and they were shut up by him in the towers, and he encamped against them and devoted them to destruction and burned its towers with fire together with all who were within.

6 And he crossed over against the sons of Ammon and found a mighty hand and many people, and Timotheos their leader;

7 and he joined many battles against them, and they were crushed before his face, and he struck them.

8 And he seized Iazer and its daughters and returned to Judaea.

9 And the nations in Galaad gathered against Israel, those within their borders, to remove them, and they fled into Dathema the fortress

10 and sent letters to Ioudas and his brothers, saying, The nations around us have gathered against us to remove us

11 and are preparing to come and seize the fortress into which we fled, and Timotheos leads their army;

12 now therefore come and deliver us from their hand, because a multitude of us has fallen,

13 and all our brothers in the places of Toubias have been put to death, and they have taken their wives and children and baggage captive, and destroyed there about a thousand-man company.

14 The letters were still being read, and behold, other messengers arrived from Galilee, having torn their garments, reporting according to these words,

15 saying that those from Ptolemais and Tyre and Sidon and all Galilee of foreigners had gathered against them to consume us utterly.

16 And when Ioudas and the people heard these words, a great assembly gathered to deliberate what they should do for their brothers who were in affliction and were being fought by them.

17 And Ioudas said to Simon his brother, Choose men for yourself and go and deliver your brothers in Galilee, but I and Ionathan my brother will go to Galaaditis.

18 And he left Iosepos son of Zacharias and Azarias, a leader of the people, with the remainder of the army in Judaea to guard it,

19 and commanded them, saying, Stand over this people and do not join battle against the nations until we return.

20 And three thousand men were allotted to Simon to go to Galilee, and eight thousand men to Ioudas for Galaaditis.

21 And Simon went to Galilee and joined many battles against the nations, and the nations were crushed before him,

22 and he pursued them as far as the gate of Ptolemais. And about three thousand men fell from the nations, and he took their spoils.

23 And he took those from Galilee and in Arbatta with their wives and children and everything they had, and brought them into Judaea with great gladness.

24 And Ioudas Makkabaios and Ionathan his brother crossed the Jordan and traveled a journey of three days in the wilderness.

25 And they met the Nabataeans, and they met them peacefully and recounted to them everything that had happened to their brothers in Galaaditis,

26 and that many of them are confined in Bosorra and Bosor, in Alema, Chaspho, Maked and Karnain; all these cities are fortified and great;

27 and they are confined in the remaining cities of Galaaditis; for tomorrow they are appointed to encamp against the fortifications and seize them and remove all these in one day.

28 And Ioudas and his army turned their route into the wilderness toward Bosorra suddenly; and he seized the city and killed every male by the mouth of the sword and took all their spoils and burned it with fire.

29 And he departed from there by night, and they traveled as far as the fortress;

30 and it happened in the morning, they lifted their eyes, and behold, many people without number, carrying ladders and engines to seize the fortress, and they were fighting them.

31 And Ioudas saw that the battle had begun and the cry of the city went up to heaven with trumpets and a great cry,

32 and he said to the men of the army, Fight today for our brothers.

33 And he went out in three divisions behind them, and they sounded the trumpets and cried in prayer.

34 And Timotheos's army recognized that it was Makkabaios, and they fled before him, and he struck them with a great blow, and about eight thousand men of them fell on that day.

35 And he turned aside to Alema and fought it and seized it and killed every male of it and took its spoils and burned it with fire.

36 From there he departed and seized Chaspho, Maked and Bosor and the remaining cities of Galaaditis.

37 And after these matters Timotheos gathered another army and encamped opposite Raphon beyond the torrent.

38 And Ioudas sent to spy out the camp, and they reported to him, saying, All the nations around us have gathered to him, an exceedingly numerous army;

39 and they have hired Arabs to help them and are encamping beyond the torrent, ready to come against you for war. And Ioudas went to meet them.

40 And Timotheos said to the commanders of his army as Ioudas and his army approached the torrent of water, If he crosses toward us first, we will not be able to withstand him, because he will surely prevail against us;

41 but if he becomes cowardly and encamps beyond the river, we will cross over toward him and prevail against him.

42 And when Ioudas approached the torrent of water, he stationed the scribes of the people at the torrent and commanded them, saying, Do not let any person encamp, but let all come to the battle.

43 And he crossed against them first, and all the people behind him, and all the nations were crushed before their face and threw down their weapons and fled into the sacred precinct of Karnain.

44 And they seized the city and burned the sacred precinct with fire together with all those in it; and Karnain was routed, and they could no longer withstand Ioudas before his face.

45 And Ioudas gathered all Israel in Galaaditis, from small to great, and their wives and their children and their baggage, an exceedingly great company, to come into the land of Iouda.

46 And they came as far as Ephron, and this was a great city on the road, exceedingly fortified; it was not possible to turn aside from it to the right or left, but only to travel through its midst;

47 and those from the city shut them out and blocked the gates with stones.

48 And Ioudas sent to them with peaceful words, saying, We will pass through your land to depart into our land, and no one will harm you; only on our feet will we pass through. And they did not wish to open to him.

49 And Ioudas commanded a proclamation in the camp that each should encamp in the place where he was;

50 and the men of the army encamped, and he fought the city all that day and all the night, and the city was handed over into his hand.

51 And he destroyed every male by the mouth of the sword and uprooted it and took its spoils and passed through the city over those who had been killed.

52 And they crossed the Jordan into the great plain opposite Baithsan.

53 And Ioudas was gathering those who fell behind and encouraging the people along the whole road until he came into the land of Iouda.

54 And they went up to Mount Sion in gladness and joy and offered burnt offerings, because none of them had fallen until they returned in peace.

55 And in the days when Ioudas and Ionathan were in the land of Galaad and Simon his brother was in Galilee opposite Ptolemais,

56 Ioseph son of Zacharias and Azarias, commanders of the army, heard of the brave deeds and the war, what things they had done,

57 and said, Let us also make a name for ourselves and go to fight against the nations around us.

58 And he gave orders to those of the army with them, and they went against Iamneia.

59 And Gorgias went out from the city, and his men, to meet them for war.

60 And Iosepos and Azarias were routed and pursued as far as the borders of Judaea, and about two thousand men of the people of Israel fell on that day.

61 And a great rout came among the people, because they did not obey Ioudas and his brothers, thinking to perform brave deeds;

62 but they were not of the seed of those men through whose hand the salvation of Israel was given.

63 And the man Ioudas and his brothers were exceedingly glorified before all Israel and all the nations wherever their name was heard;

64 and they gathered to them, speaking praise.

65 And Ioudas and his brothers went out and fought the sons of Esau in the land toward the south, and he struck Chebron and its daughters and tore down its fortifications and burned its towers all around.

66 And he departed to go into the land of foreigners and traveled through Marisa.

67 On that day priests fell in war, wishing to perform brave deeds by going out into war without deliberation.

68 And Ioudas turned aside to Azotos in the land of foreigners and tore down their altars and burned the carved images of their gods with fire and plundered the spoils of the cities and returned into the land of Iouda.

Chapter 6

1 And King Antiochos traveled through the upper countries and heard that Elymais in Persia was a city glorious in wealth, silver and gold;

2 and the temple in it was exceedingly rich, and there were golden coverings and breastplates and weapons which Alexandros son of Philippos, the Macedonian king who reigned first among the Greeks, left there.

3 And he came and sought to seize the city and plunder it, and could not, because the matter became known to those of the city,

4 and they opposed him in war, and he fled and departed from there with great grief to return to Babylon.

5 And someone came reporting to him in Persia that the armies which went into the land of Iouda had been routed,

6 and Lysias went with a strong army among the foremost and was put to flight before them, and they grew strong with weapons and an army and many spoils which they took from the armies they cut down,

7 and tore down the abomination which he built upon the altar in Jerusalem, and surrounded the sanctuary with high walls as formerly, and Baithsoura his city.

8 And it happened when the king heard these words, he was astonished and exceedingly shaken and fell upon his bed and fell into sickness from grief, because it did not happen for him as he intended.

9 And he was there for several days, because great grief was renewed upon him, and he reckoned that he was dying.

10 And he called all his friends and said to them, Sleep departs from my eyes, and I have collapsed in heart from anxiety,

11 and I said in my heart, To what affliction have I come, and what great surge in which I now am? For I was kind and beloved in my authority.

12 But now I remember the evils which I did in Jerusalem, and I took all the silver and golden vessels in it and sent to remove the inhabitants of Iouda without cause.

13 I know that because of these things these evils have found me; and behold, I perish with great grief in a foreign land.

14 And he called Philippos, one of his friends, and appointed him over his whole kingdom;

15 and he gave him the diadem and his robe and ring, to guide Antiochos his son and rear him to reign.

16 And King Antiochos died there in the one hundred forty-ninth year.

17 And Lysias learned that the king had died, and appointed Antiochos his son, whom he had reared when younger, to reign, and called his name Eupator.

18 And those from the citadel were shutting Israel in around the holy things and seeking evils throughout and a support for the nations.

19 And Ioudas resolved to remove them and called all the people into assembly to besiege them;

20 and they gathered together and besieged it in the one hundred fiftieth year, and he made stations for missiles and engines.

21 And some of them came out from the confinement, and some of the ungodly from Israel joined them,

22 and they went to the king and said, How long will you not execute judgment and avenge our brothers?

23 We willingly serve your father and walk according to what he says and follow his ordinances.

24 And the sons of our people besieged it because of this and became estranged from us; moreover, all of us who were found were put to death, and our inheritances were plundered.

25 And they stretched out a hand not only against us but also against all their borders;

26 and behold, today they have encamped against the citadel in Jerusalem to seize it; and they fortified the sanctuary and Baithsoura;

27 and unless you forestall them quickly, they will do greater things than these, and you will not be able to restrain them.

28 And the king became angry when he heard, and gathered all his friends, commanders of his army and those over the reins;

29 and from other kingdoms and from islands of seas hired armies came to him;

30 and the number of his armies was a hundred thousand infantry and twenty thousand cavalry and thirty-two elephants that knew war.

31 And they came through Idumaea and encamped against Baithsoura and fought for many days and made engines; and they went out and burned them with fire and fought manfully.

32 And Ioudas departed from the citadel and encamped at Baithzacharia opposite the king's army.

33 And the king rose early in the morning and moved the army in its assault along the road to Baithzacharia, and the armies were prepared for war and sounded the trumpets.

34 And they showed the elephants the blood of grapes and mulberries to rouse them for war.

35 And they divided the beasts among the phalanxes and stationed with each elephant a thousand men armored in chain mail, and bronze helmets upon their heads, and five hundred chosen cavalry assigned to each beast;

36 these were beforehand wherever the beast was, and wherever it went they went together; they did not depart from it.

37 And strong covered wooden towers were upon them, upon each beast, fastened upon it by devices, and upon each four men of the army who fought upon them, and its Indian.

38 And he stationed the remaining cavalry on this side and that, on the two sides of the army, brandishing weapons and protecting themselves within the phalanxes.

39 And as the sun gleamed upon the golden and bronze shields, the mountains gleamed from them and shone like torches of fire.

40 And a certain part of the king's army extended over the high mountains, and some over the low places; and they came securely and in order.

41 And all who heard the sound of their multitude and the marching of the multitude and the clash of the weapons were shaken; for the army was exceedingly great and strong.

42 And Ioudas and his army drew near for battle, and six hundred men fell from the king's army.

43 And Eleazaros Auaran saw one of the beasts armored with royal breastplates, and it surpassed all the beasts, and he thought that the king was upon it;

44 and he gave himself to save his people and acquire an everlasting name for himself;

45 and he ran boldly toward it into the midst of the phalanx and put to death on the right and left, and they split away from him on this side and that;

46 and he slipped under the elephant and thrust beneath it and killed it, and it fell upon the earth on top of him, and he died there.

47 And they saw the strength of the kingdom and the assault of the armies and turned away from them.

48 And those from the king's army went up to meet them in Jerusalem, and the king encamped in Judaea and at Mount Sion.

49 And he made peace with those from Baithsoura, and they went out from the city, because they had no sustenance there to be shut up in it, because it was a sabbath for the land;

50 and the king seized Baithsoura and stationed a garrison there to guard it.

51 And he encamped against the sanctuary for many days and stationed there missile stations and engines and fire throwers and stone throwers and small scorpions for shooting missiles and slings.

52 And they also made engines against their engines and fought for many days.

53 But there was no food in the vessels because it was the seventh year, and those who were saved into Judaea from the nations had eaten up the remainder of the stored provisions.

54 And few men remained in the holy places, because famine overcame them, and they scattered, each to his own place.

55 And Lysias heard that Philippos, whom King Antiochos appointed while he was still living to rear Antiochos his son so that he might reign,

56 had returned from Persia and Media, and the armies which went with the king were with him, and that he seeks to take over the affairs.

57 And he hastened and assented to departing, and said to the king and the leaders of the army and the men, We diminish each day, and our food is little, and the place where we encamp is fortified, and the affairs of the kingdom press upon us;

58 now therefore let us give right hands to these people and make peace with them and with their whole nation,

59 and establish for them that they may walk in their customs as formerly; for because of their customs which we abolished they became angry and did all these things.

60 And the word pleased the king and the rulers, and he sent to them to make peace, and they accepted.

61 And the king and the rulers swore to them; on these terms they went out from the fortress.

62 And the king entered Mount Sion and saw the fortification of the place and rejected the oath which he swore and commanded that the wall be torn down all around.

63 And he departed in haste and returned to Antioch and found Philippos ruling the city and fought against him and seized the city by force.

Chapter 7

1 In the one hundred fifty-first year Demetrios son of Seleukos went out from Rome and went up with a few men into a seaside city and reigned there.

2 And it happened as he entered the house of the kingdom of his fathers, the armies seized Antiochos and Lysias to bring them to him.

3 And the matter became known to him, and he said, Do not show me their faces.

4 And the armies killed them, and Demetrios sat upon the throne of his kingdom.

5 And all the lawless and ungodly men from Israel came to him, and Alkimos led them, wishing to be priest.

6 And they accused the people before the king, saying, Ioudas and his brothers destroyed all your friends and scattered us from our land;

7 now therefore send a man whom you trust, and let him go and see all the destruction which he did to us and to the king's country, and let him punish them and all who assist them.

8 And the king chose Bakchides, of the king's friends, ruling beyond the river and great in the kingdom and faithful to the king,

9 and sent him and the ungodly Alkimos and established the priesthood for him and commanded him to execute vengeance upon the sons of Israel.

10 And they departed and came with a numerous army into the land of Iouda; and he sent messengers to Ioudas and his brothers with peaceful words in deceit.

11 And they did not attend to their words; for they saw that they came with a numerous army.

12 And an assembly of scribes gathered to Alkimos and Bakchides to seek just things,

13 and the Asidaians were first among the sons of Israel and sought peace from them;

14 for they said, A man, a priest of the seed of Aaron, has come with the armies and will not wrong us.

15 And he spoke peaceful words with them and swore to them, saying, We will not seek evil for you and your friends.

16 And they trusted him; and he seized sixty men of them and killed them in one day according to the word which he wrote,

17 The flesh of your holy ones and their blood they poured out around Jerusalem, and there was no one to bury them.

18 And fear and trembling of them fell upon all the people, because they said, There is no truth and judgment in them, for they transgressed the agreement and the oath which they swore.

19 And Bakchides departed from Jerusalem and encamped at Bethzaith and sent and seized many of the men who had deserted to him, and some of the people, and slaughtered them into the great well.

20 And he committed the country to Alkimos and left an army with him to help him; and Bakchides departed to the king.

21 And Alkimos struggled for the high priesthood,

22 and all who troubled their people gathered to him and took hold of the land of Iouda and inflicted a great blow in Israel.

23 And Ioudas saw all the wickedness which Alkimos and those with him did among the sons of Israel, beyond the nations,

24 and went out into all the borders of Judaea around it and executed vengeance upon the men who deserted, and they were restrained from going out into the country.

25 And when Alkimos saw that Ioudas and those with him had grown strong, and knew that he could not withstand them, he returned to the king and accused them of evil things.

26 And the king sent Nikanor, one of his glorious rulers, who hated Israel and was hostile to it, and commanded him to remove the people.

27 And Nikanor came to Jerusalem with a numerous army and sent to Ioudas and his brothers in deceit with peaceful words, saying,

28 Let there be no battle between me and you; I will come with a few men so that I may see your faces in peace.

29 And he came to Ioudas, and they greeted one another peacefully; and the enemies were ready to seize Ioudas.

30 And the matter became known to Ioudas, that he came against him in deceit, and he was alarmed by him and no longer wished to see his face.

31 And Nikanor knew that his plan had been uncovered, and went out to meet Ioudas in war near Chapharsalama.

32 And about five hundred men of those with Nikanor fell, and they fled into the city of Dauid.

33 And after these words Nikanor went up to Mount Sion. And some of the priests went out from the holy places, and some of the elders of the people, to greet him peacefully and show him the burnt offering being offered for the king.

34 And he sneered at them and laughed at them and defiled them and spoke arrogantly;

35 and he swore with wrath, saying, Unless Ioudas and his army are handed over into my hands now, it will happen, if I return in peace, that I will burn this house. And he went out with great wrath.

36 And the priests entered and stood before the face of the altar and the temple and wept and said,

37 You chose this house for your name to be invoked upon it, to be a house of prayer and supplication for your people;

38 execute vengeance upon this man and his army, and let them fall by the sword; remember their evil speech and do not give them continuance.

39 And Nikanor went out from Jerusalem and encamped in Baithoron, and an army of Syria met him.

40 And Ioudas encamped in Adasa with three thousand men; and Ioudas prayed and said,

41 When those from the king spoke evil, your angel went out and struck a hundred eighty-five thousand among them;

42 thus crush this army before us today, and let the remainder know that he spoke evilly against your holy things, and judge him according to his wickedness.

43 And the armies joined battle on the thirteenth of the month Adar, and Nikanor's army was crushed, and he fell first in the battle.

44 And when his army saw that Nikanor had fallen, they threw down their weapons and fled.

45 And they pursued them a journey of one day from Adasa until coming to Gazera and sounded the signaling trumpets behind them.

46 And they went out from all the villages of Judaea around it and outflanked them, and these turned back toward those, and they all fell by the sword, and not even one of them was left.

47 And they took the spoils and plunder, and cut off Nikanor's head and his right hand which he had stretched out arrogantly, and brought them and displayed them beside Jerusalem.

48 And the people were exceedingly glad, and observed that day as a great day of gladness;

49 and they established that this day should be observed each year on the thirteenth of Adar.

50 And the land of Iouda was quiet for a few days.

Chapter 8

1 And Ioudas heard the name of the Romans, that they are mighty in strength and they take pleasure in all those joining them, and as many as approach them, they establish friendship with them, and that they are mighty in strength.

2 And they related to him their wars and the deeds of courage which they do among the Galatians, and that they prevailed over them and brought them under tribute,

3 and whatever they did in the land of Spain to gain possession of the mines of silver and gold there;

4 and they gained possession of the whole place by their counsel and their patience, and the place was very far distant from them, and of the kings who came against them from the end of the earth, until they crushed them and struck a great blow among them, and those remaining give them tribute yearly;

5 and Philip and Perseus, king of the Kitians, and those raised up against them, they crushed them in war and prevailed over them;

6 and Antiochos, the great king of Asia, who went against them for war, having one hundred and twenty elephants and cavalry and chariots and a very great force, and he was crushed by them,

7 and they took him alive and established that he and those reigning after him should give them great tribute and give hostages and a stipulated agreement

8 and the Indian land and Media and Lydia, from their finest lands, and having taken them from him, they gave them to Eumenes the king;

9 and that those from Greece planned to come and remove them,

10 and the matter became known to them, and they sent one commander against them and fought against them, and many wounded fell from among them, and they took their wives and their children captive and plundered them and gained possession of the land and pulled down their strongholds and enslaved them until this day;

11 and the remaining kingdoms and the islands, as many as ever stood against them, they destroyed and enslaved them, but with their friends and those relying on them they maintained friendship;

12 and they prevailed over the kings nearby and those far away, and as many as heard their name were afraid of them.

13 And those whom they wish to help and to reign, reign; but those whom they wish, they remove; and they were greatly exalted.

14 And in all these things not even one of them put on a diadem, nor did they clothe themselves in purple so as to be magnified in it;

15 and they made themselves a council chamber, and daily three hundred and twenty deliberated, deliberating continually concerning the multitude, that they should be well ordered;

16 and they entrust one man to rule them yearly and to exercise lordship over all their land, and all obey the one, and there is no envy or jealousy among them.

17 And Ioudas selected Eupolemos, son of Ioannes, of Akkos, and Iason, son of Eleazar, and sent them to Rome to establish friendship and alliance

18 and to lift the yoke from them, because they saw the kingdom of the Greeks enslaving Israel with slavery.

19 And they went to Rome, and the journey was very long, and they entered the council chamber and answered and said,

20 Ioudas, also called Makkabaios, and his brothers and the multitude of the Judeans sent us to you to establish alliance and peace with you and for us to be registered as your allies and friends.

21 And the statement was pleasing before them.

22 And this is the copy of the letter which they copied on bronze tablets and sent to Ierousalem to be with them there as a memorial of peace and alliance:

23 May it go well with the Romans and the nation of the Judeans on the sea and on the dry land forever, and may sword and enemy be put far from them.

24 But if war arises first for Rome or for all their allies in all their dominion,

25 the nation of the Judeans shall act as allies, as the occasion prescribes for them, with a full heart;

26 and to those waging war they shall not give or supply grain, weapons, silver, ships, as Rome decided; and they shall keep their obligations, taking nothing.

27 And in the same way, if war happens first to the nation of the Judeans, the Romans shall act as allies from the soul, as the occasion prescribes for them?

28 And to those allied, grain, weapons, silver, ships shall not be given, as Rome decided; and they shall keep these obligations, and without deceit. —

29 According to these words the Romans thus established an agreement with the people of the Judeans.

30 But if after these words these and those decide to add or remove, they shall do so by their own choice, and whatever they add or remove shall be authoritative.

31 And concerning the evils which King Demetrios carries out against them, we wrote to him, saying, Why have you made your yoke heavy upon our friends, the allied Judeans?

32 If therefore they petition against you again, we shall execute judgment for them and wage war against you by sea and by dry land.

Chapter 9

1 And Demetrios heard that Nikanor and his force had fallen in war, and he proceeded to send Bakchides and Alkimos a second time into the land of Iouda, and the right wing with them.

2 And they went by the road to Galgala and encamped against Maisaloth in Arbela and seized it beforehand and destroyed many human lives.

3 And in the first month of the one hundred and fifty-second year they encamped against Ierousalem;

4 and they departed and went to Berea with twenty thousand men and two thousand cavalry.

5 And Ioudas was encamped in Elasa, and three thousand chosen men with him.

6 And they saw the multitude of the forces, that they were many, and were very afraid; and many slipped away from the camp; none were left of them except eight hundred men.

7 And Ioudas saw that his camp had slipped away and the war was pressing him, and he was crushed in heart, because he had no opportunity to gather them,

8 and he grew faint and said to those left, Let us arise and go up against our adversaries, if perhaps we can fight against them.

9 And they tried to turn him back, saying, We certainly cannot, but let us save our own lives now; let us return, and our brothers, and fight against them, but we are few.

10 And Ioudas said, May it not happen that we do this thing, flee from them; and if our time has drawn near, let us also die with courage for the sake of our brothers and not leave a charge against our glory.

11 And the force departed from the camp and they stood to meet them, and the cavalry was divided into two parts, and the slingers and the archers went before the force, and the foremost fighters, all the mighty men, but Bakchides was in the right wing.

12 And the phalanx drew near from the two parts and they sounded with the trumpets, and those with Ioudas also blew with the trumpets;

13 and the earth was shaken by the sound of the camps, and the battle was joined from morning until evening.

14 And Ioudas saw that Bakchides and the strength of the camp were on the right, and all those courageous in heart came together with him,

15 and the right part was crushed by them, and he pursued after them as far as Mount Azotos.

16 And those in the left wing saw that the right wing was crushed, and they turned on the heels of Ioudas and those with him from behind.

17 And the battle became heavy, and many wounded fell from these and from those,

18 and Ioudas fell, and the rest fled.

19 And Ionathan and Simon lifted Ioudas their brother and buried him in the tomb of his fathers in Modein.

20 And all Israel wept for him and lamented him with a great lamentation and mourned for many days and said,

21 How a mighty man has fallen, who saved Israel.

22 And the remaining accounts of Ioudas and the wars and the deeds of courage which he did, and his greatness, were not recorded; for they were very many.

23 And it happened after the death of Ioudas that the lawless emerged in all the borders of Israel, and all those working injustice sprang up.

24 In those days a very great famine occurred, and the land deserted to their side.

25 And Bakchides chose the impious men and appointed them masters of the land.

26 And they sought out and searched for the friends of Ioudas and brought them to Bakchides, and he punished them and mocked them.

27 And great affliction came in Israel, such as had not occurred from the day when a prophet was not seen by them.

28 And all the friends of Ioudas were gathered and said to Ionathan,

29 Since your brother Ioudas has died, and there is no man like him to go out and come in against the enemies and Bakchides and among those hostile to our nation;

30 now therefore we have chosen you today to be for us in his place as ruler and leader, to fight our war.

31 And Ionathan accepted the leadership at that time and arose in place of Ioudas his brother.

32 And Bakchides learned of it and sought to kill him.

33 And Ionathan and Simon his brother and all those with him learned of it and fled into the wilderness of Thekoe and encamped by the water of the pool Asphar.

34 And Bakchides learned of it on the sabbath day and came, he and all his army, beyond the Iordan. —

35 And he sent his brother, leader of the crowd, and entreated the Nabateans, his friends, to deposit with them their abundant baggage.

36 And the sons of Iambri from Medaba came out and seized Ioannes and all that he had and departed with it.

37 After these matters they reported to Ionathan and Simon his brother that the sons of Iambri are holding a great wedding and are bringing the bride from Nadabath, daughter of one of the great nobles of Chanaan, with a great escort.

38 And they remembered the blood of Ioannes their brother and went up and hid under the shelter of the mountain.

39 And they lifted their eyes and saw, and behold, a commotion and abundant baggage, and the bridegroom came out, and his friends and his brothers, to meet them with drums and musicians and many weapons.

40 And they rose against them from the ambush and killed them, and many wounded fell, and those remaining fled into the mountain; and they took all their spoils.

41 And the wedding was turned into mourning and the sound of their musicians into lamentation.

42 And they exacted vengeance for the blood of their brother and returned to the marsh of the Iordan. —

43 And Bakchides heard and came on the sabbath day as far as the banks of the Iordan with a great force.

44 And Ionathan said to those with him, Let us now arise and fight for our lives, for today is not as yesterday and the third day;

45 for behold, the battle is in front and behind us, and the water of the Iordan on this side and that side, and marsh and woodland; there is no place to turn aside;

46 now therefore cry out to heaven, so that you may be saved from the hand of our enemies.

47 And the battle joined; and Ionathan stretched out his hand to strike Bakchides, and he turned aside from him backward.

48 And Ionathan and those with him leaped into the Iordan and swam across to the other side, and they did not cross the Iordan against them.

49 And on that day about a thousand men fell on Bakchides' side.

50 And he returned to Ierousalem, and they built fortified cities in Judea, the stronghold in Iericho and Ammaous and Baithoron and Baithel and Thamnatha Pharathon and Tephon, with high walls and gates and bars;

51 and he placed a garrison in them to act against Israel.

52 And he fortified the city Baithsoura and Gazara and the citadel and placed forces and stores of food in them.

53 And he took the sons of the leaders of the land as hostages and placed them in the citadel in Ierousalem under guard.

54 And in the one hundred and fifty-third year, in the second month, Alkimos ordered the wall of the inner court of the holy places to be pulled down; and he pulled down the works of the prophets and began to pull down.

55 At that time Alkimos was struck, and his works were hindered, and his mouth was stopped, and he was paralyzed and could no longer speak a word or give orders concerning his house.

56 And Alkimos died at that time with great torment.

57 And Bakchides saw that Alkimos had died and returned to the king. And the land of Iouda was quiet for two years.

58 And all the lawless plotted, saying, Behold, Ionathan and those with him dwell in quiet, confidently; now therefore we shall bring up Bakchides, and he will seize them all in one night.

59 And they went and counseled him.

60 And he departed to come with a great force and secretly sent letters to all his allies in Judea, that they should seize Ionathan and those with him; and they could not, because their plan became known.

61 And they seized about fifty men from the men of the land, the leaders of the wickedness, and killed them.

62 And Ionathan and Simon and those with him withdrew to Baithbasi in the wilderness, and he rebuilt its demolished parts, and they strengthened it.

63 And Bakchides learned of it and gathered all his multitude and gave orders to those from Judea;

64 and he came and encamped against Baithbasi and fought against it for many days and made engines.

65 And Ionathan left Simon his brother in the city and went out into the country and came with a number of men.

66 And he struck Odomera and his brothers and the sons of Phasiron in their dwelling, and they began to strike and went up with the forces.

67 And Simon and those with him came out of the city and burned the engines;

68 and they fought against Bakchides, and he was crushed by them, and they afflicted him greatly, because his plan and his assault were empty.

69 And he was angry in wrath with the lawless men who had counseled him to come into the country and killed many of them and decided to depart to his own land.

70 And Ionathan learned of it and sent ambassadors to him to agree on peace with him and to return the captives to them.

71 And he accepted and did according to his words and swore to him not to seek harm for him all the days of his life;

72 and he returned to him the captives whom he had previously taken captive from the land of Iouda, and he turned back and departed to his own land and did not again come into their borders.

73 And the sword ceased from Israel; and Ionathan dwelt in Machmas, and Ionathan began to judge the people and removed the impious from Israel.

Chapter 10

1 And in the one hundred and sixtieth year Alexandros, the son of Antiochos, the Illustrious, went up and seized Ptolemais, and they received him, and he reigned there.

2 And Demetrios the king heard and gathered very many forces and went out to meet him for war.

3 And Demetrios sent letters to Ionathan with peaceful words so as to magnify him;

4 for he said, Let us act first to establish peace with them before he establishes it with Alexandros against us;

5 for he will remember all the evils which we carried out against him and against his brothers and against the nation.

6 And he gave him authority to gather forces and prepare weapons and to be his ally, and he said to hand over to him the hostages in the citadel.

7 And Ionathan came to Ierousalem and read the letters into the ears of all the people and those from the citadel.

8 And they feared with great fear when they heard that the king had given him authority to gather a force.

9 And those from the citadel handed the hostages over to Ionathan, and he returned them to their parents.

10 And Ionathan dwelt in Ierousalem and began to build and renew the city.

11 And he told those doing the works to build the walls and Mount Sion all around with four-foot stones for fortification, and they did so.

12 And the foreigners who were in the strongholds which Bakchides had built fled,

13 and each left his place and departed to his own land;

14 except in Baithsoura some of those who had abandoned the law and the ordinances remained; for it was a refuge.

15 And Alexandros the king heard the promises, as many as Demetrios had sent to Ionathan, and they related to him the wars and the deeds of courage which he and his brothers had done, and the labors which they had endured,

16 and he said, Surely we shall not find one such man? And now we shall make him our friend and ally.

17 And he wrote letters and sent them to him according to these words, saying,

18 King Alexandros to his brother Ionathan, greetings.

19 We have heard concerning you that you are a man mighty in strength and fit to be our friend.

20 And now we have appointed you today high priest of your nation and for you to be called a friend of the king [and he sent him purple and a golden crown] and to think of our affairs and maintain friendship toward us.

21 And Ionathan put on the holy robe in the seventh month of the one hundred and sixtieth year, at the feast of tent-pitching, and gathered forces and prepared many weapons.

22 And Demetrios heard these words and was grieved and said,

23 What is this we have done, that Alexandros has anticipated us in gaining friendship with the Judeans as a support?

24 I too shall write them words of encouragement and exaltation and gifts, so that they may be with me for help.

25 And he sent to them according to these words: King Demetrios to the nation of the Judeans, greetings.

26 Since you have maintained the agreements with us and remained in our friendship and have not gone over to our enemies, we heard and rejoiced.

27 And now continue still to maintain faithfulness toward us, and we shall repay you good things in return for what you do with us.

28 And we shall grant you many remissions and give you gifts.

29 And now I release you and exempt all the Judeans from the tributes and the price of salt and from the crowns,

30 and instead of the third of the sowing and instead of the half of the fruit of the trees which falls to me to receive, I remit from today and onward the receiving of it from the land of Iouda and from the three districts added to it from Samaria and Galilee, from today and for all time.

31 And let Ierousalem be holy and exempt, and its borders, the tithes and the taxes.

32 I also relinquish authority over the citadel in Ierousalem and give it to the high priest, so that he may appoint in it men whom he himself chooses to guard it.

33 And every soul of the Judeans taken captive from the land of Iouda into any part of my kingdom I release free without payment; and let all remit the tributes, also those on their livestock.

34 And all the feasts and the sabbaths and new moons and appointed days, and three days before a feast and three after a feast, let them all be days of exemption and remission for all the Judeans who are in my kingdom,

35 and no one shall have authority to exact payment and trouble any of them concerning any matter.

36 And let about thirty thousand men of the Judeans be enrolled in the forces of the king, and allowances shall be given to them, as is fitting for all the forces of the king.

37 And some of them shall be appointed in the great strongholds of the king, and from these some shall be appointed over affairs of the kingdom that require trust; and let those over them and the rulers be from among them, and let them walk by their own laws, as the king also ordered in the land of Iouda.

38 And the three districts added to Judea from the country of Samaria, let them be added to Judea to be reckoned as being under one, so as not to obey another authority except the high priest.

39 I have given Ptolemais and the territory belonging to it as a gift to the holy places in Ierousalem for the expenditure due to the holy places.

40 And I give yearly fifteen thousand shekels of silver from the accounts of the king, from the appropriate places.

41 And all the surplus which they did not pay from the revenues as in the first years, from now they shall give for the works of the house.

42 And besides these, five thousand shekels of silver which they used to receive yearly from the revenues of the holy place from the account, these also are remitted because they belong to the priests who minister.

43 And as many as flee to the temple in Ierosolyma and within all its borders, owing royal dues or any obligation, let them be released, and all that belongs to them in my kingdom.

44 And for the works of the holy places to be built and renewed, the expense shall also be given from the account of the king.

45 And for the walls of Ierousalem to be built and fortified all around, the expense shall also be given from the account of the king, and for the walls in Judea to be built.

46 But when Ionathan and the people heard these words, they did not believe them or accept them, because they remembered the great wickedness which he had done in Israel and had afflicted them greatly.

47 And they were pleased with Alexandros, because he had become for them the initiator of peaceful words, and they acted as his allies all the days.

48 And Alexandros the king gathered great forces and encamped opposite Demetrios.

49 And the two kings joined battle, and the camp of Demetrios fled, and Alexandros pursued him and prevailed over them;

50 and he pressed the battle very hard until the sun set, and Demetrios fell on that day.

51 And Alexandros sent ambassadors to Ptolemaios, king of Egypt, according to these words, saying,

52 Since I returned to my kingdom and sat on the throne of my fathers and took hold of the rule, and crushed Demetrios and gained possession of our country

53 and joined battle against him, and he and his camp were crushed by us, and we sat on the throne of his kingdom;

54 and now let us establish friendship with one another, and now give me your daughter as wife, and I shall become your son-in-law and give gifts to you and to her worthy of you.

55 And Ptolemaios the king answered, saying, Good is the day on which you returned to the land of your fathers and sat on the throne of their kingdom.

56 And now I shall do for you what you wrote, but meet me at Ptolemais, so that we may see one another, and I shall become related to you by marriage, as you have said.

57 And Ptolemaios went out from Egypt, he and Kleopatra his daughter, and came to Ptolemais in the one hundred and sixty-second year.

58 And Alexandros the king met him, and he gave him Kleopatra his daughter in marriage and held her wedding in Ptolemais as kings do, with great glory. —

59 And Alexandros the king wrote to Ionathes to come to meet him.

60 And he went with glory to Ptolemais and met the two kings; and he gave them silver and gold, and to their friends, and many gifts, and found favor before them.

61 And pestilent men from Israel, lawless men, gathered against him to petition against him, and the king did not pay attention to them.

62 And the king ordered, and they stripped Ionathan of his garments and clothed him in purple, and they did so.

63 And the king seated him with himself and said to his rulers, Go out with him into the midst of the city and proclaim that no one is to petition against him concerning any matter, and let no one trouble him concerning any statement.

64 And it happened when those petitioning saw his glory, as he had proclaimed, and him clothed in purple, that they all fled.

65 And the king glorified him and registered him among the first friends and appointed him commander and governor of a district.

66 And Ionathan returned to Ierousalem with peace and gladness.

67 And in the one hundred and sixty-fifth year Demetrios, son of Demetrios, came from Crete into the land of his fathers.

68 And Alexandros the king heard and was greatly grieved and returned to Antiocheia.

69 And Demetrios appointed Apollonios, who was over Coele Syria, and he gathered a great force and encamped against Iamneia; and he sent to Ionathan the high priest, saying,

70 You alone raise yourself against us, but I have become a laughingstock and a reproach because of you; and why do you exercise power against us in the mountains?

71 Now therefore, if you trust in your forces, come down to us into the plain, and let us contend with one another there, because with me is a force from the cities.

72 Ask and learn who I am and the rest who help us, and they say, You have no foothold before us, because your fathers were routed twice in their land.

73 And now you will not be able to withstand the cavalry and such a force in the plain, where there is no stone or pebble or place to flee.

74 But when Ionathan heard the words of Apollonios, he was stirred in his mind and selected ten thousand men and went out from Ierousalem, and Simon his brother met him to help him.

75 And he encamped against Ioppe, and those from the city shut it, because a garrison of Apollonios was in Ioppe; and they fought against it,

76 and those from the city became afraid and opened it, and Ionathan became master of Ioppe.

77 And Apollonios heard and encamped with three thousand cavalry and a great force and went to Azotos as though passing through, and at the same time advanced into the plain because he had a multitude of cavalry and trusted in it.

78 And he pursued after him to Azotos, and the camps joined in battle.

79 And Apollonios left a thousand cavalry secretly behind them.

80 And Ionathan knew that there was an ambush behind him, and they surrounded his camp and hurled the shafts at the people from morning until evening;

81 but the people stood as Ionathan had ordered, and their horses grew weary.

82 And Simon brought his force forward and joined against the phalanx, for the cavalry had grown faint, and they were crushed by him and fled,

83 and the cavalry was scattered in the plain. And they fled to Azotos and entered Bethdagon, their idol temple, to be saved.

84 And Ionathan burned Azotos and the cities around it and took their spoils, and the temple of Dagon and those who had fled together into it he burned with fire.

85 And those fallen by the sword, together with those burned, amounted to about eight thousand men.

86 And Ionathan departed from there and encamped against Askalon, and those from the city came out to meet him with great glory.

87 And Ionathan returned to Ierousalem with those with him, having many spoils.

88 And it happened when Alexandros the king heard these matters, that he proceeded to glorify Ionathan further;

89 and he sent him a golden clasp, as it is customary to give to the relatives of kings, and gave him Akkaron and all its borders as an inheritance.

Chapter 11

1 And the king of Egypt gathered many forces, like the sand beside the shore of the sea, and many ships, and sought to gain possession of the kingdom of Alexandros by deceit and add it to his own kingdom.

2 And he went out into Syria with peaceful words, and those from the cities opened to him and met him, because there was a command of Alexandros the king to meet him because he was his father-in-law;

3 but as Ptolemaios entered the cities, he stationed the forces as a garrison in each city.

4 But when they drew near Azotos, they showed him the temple of Dagon burned and Azotos and its surrounding towns demolished and the bodies cast down and those burned whom he had burned in the war; for they had made heaps of them in his path.

5 And they related to the king what Ionathan had done, to blame him; and the king was silent.

6 And Ionathan met the king at Ioppe with glory, and they greeted one another and slept there.

7 And Ionathan went with the king as far as the river called Eleutheros and returned to Ierousalem.

8 But King Ptolemaios became master of the coastal cities as far as Seleukeia by the sea and considered wicked designs concerning Alexandros.

9 And he sent ambassadors to Demetrios the king, saying, Come, let us make a covenant with one another, and I shall give you my daughter whom Alexandros had, and you shall reign over the kingdom of your father;

10 for I regret giving him my daughter, for he sought to kill me.

11 And he blamed him because he desired his kingdom;

12 and having taken his daughter away from him, he gave her to Demetrios and became estranged from Alexandros, and their enmity became evident.

13 And Ptolemaios entered Antiocheia and put on the diadem of Asia; and he put two diadems around his head, that of Egypt and of Asia.

14 But Alexandros the king was in Cilicia at those times, because those from those places were revolting.

15 And Alexandros heard and came against him in war. And Ptolemaios led out and met him with a strong hand and routed him;

16 and Alexandros fled into Arabia to be sheltered there, but King Ptolemaios was exalted.

17 And Zabdiel the Arab removed the head of Alexandros and sent it to Ptolemaios.

18 And King Ptolemaios died on the third day, and those who were in his strongholds were destroyed by those in the strongholds.

19 And Demetrios reigned in the one hundred and sixty-seventh year.

20 In those days Ionathan gathered those from Judea to wage war against the citadel in Ierousalem and made many engines against it.

21 And some lawless men who hated their nation went to the king and reported to him that Ionathan was besieging the citadel.

22 And on hearing it he became angry; and when he heard, he immediately set out and came to Ptolemais and wrote to Ionathan not to besiege it and to meet him, to confer with him in Ptolemais as quickly as possible.

23 But when Ionathan heard, he ordered the siege to continue and selected some of the elders of Israel and of the priests and gave himself to the danger;

24 and taking silver and gold and clothing and many other gifts, he also went to the king in Ptolemais and found favor before him.

25 And some lawless men from the nation were petitioning against him.

26 And the king did for him as those before him had done for him and exalted him before all his friends.

27 And he confirmed for him the high priesthood and whatever other honors he previously had and caused him to be reckoned among the first friends.

28 And Ionathan requested the king to make Judea free of tribute, and the three districts and Samaria, and promised him three hundred talents.

29 And the king consented and wrote letters to Ionathan concerning all these things, having this form:

30 King Demetrios to Ionathan his brother and to the nation of the Judeans, greetings.

31 The copy of the letter which we wrote to Lasthenes our relative concerning you we have also written to you, so that you may know.

32 King Demetrios to Lasthenes his father, greetings.

33 We decided to do good to the nation of the Judeans, our friends, who maintain their just obligations toward us, because of their goodwill toward us.

34 We have confirmed for them both the borders of Judea and the three districts Aphairema and Lydda and Rathamin; they were added to Judea from Samaria, and all that belongs to them, for all those sacrificing in Ierosolyma, in place of the royal dues which the king previously received from them yearly from the produce of the land and the fruits of the trees.

35 And the other things belonging to us from now, of the tithes and the taxes belonging to us, and the salt lakes and the crowns belonging to us, we shall grant them all.

36 And not even one of these shall be set aside from now for all time.

37 Now therefore take care to make a copy of these, and let it be given to Ionathan and placed on the holy mountain in a conspicuous place.

38 And Demetrios the king saw that the land was quiet before him and nothing stood against him, and he discharged all his forces, each to his own place, except the foreign forces which he had recruited from the islands of the nations; and all the forces inherited from the fathers became hostile to him.

39 But Tryphon was formerly among those with Alexandros and saw that all the forces were murmuring against Demetrios, and he went to Imalkoue the Arab, who was raising Antiochos, the little boy of Alexandros.

40 And he pressed him to hand him over to him, so that he might reign in place of his father; and he reported to him whatever Demetrios had carried out and the enmity with which his forces were hostile to him, and he remained there many days.

41 And Ionathan sent to Demetrios the king, that he should expel those from the citadel from Ierousalem and those in the strongholds; for they were fighting Israel.

42 And Demetrios sent to Ionathan, saying, I shall do not only these things for you and your nation, but with glory I shall glorify you and your nation, if I obtain an opportunity;

43 now therefore you will do rightly by sending me men who will act as my allies, because all my forces have revolted.

44 And Ionathan sent him three thousand men mighty in strength to Antiocheia, and they came to the king, and the king rejoiced at their arrival.

45 And those from the city gathered into the midst of the city, about one hundred and twenty thousand men, and wished to kill the king.

46 And the king fled into the court, and those from the city seized the passages of the city and began to fight.

47 And the king called the Judeans for help, and they all gathered to him together and scattered in the city and killed about one hundred thousand on that day;

48 and they burned the city and took many spoils on that day and saved the king.

49 And those from the city saw that the Judeans had gained possession of the city as they wished, and they grew weak in their minds and cried out to the king with entreaty, saying,

50 Give us your right hands, and let the Judeans stop fighting us and the city.

51 And they threw down their weapons and made peace. And the Judeans were glorified before the king and before all those in his kingdom and returned to Ierousalem with many spoils.

52 And Demetrios the king sat on the throne of his kingdom, and the land was quiet before him.

53 And he proved false in everything he had said and became estranged from Ionathan and did not repay the kindnesses which he had rendered him, and afflicted him greatly.

54 But after these things Tryphon returned, and Antiochos with him, a young boy; and he reigned and put on a diadem.

55 And all the forces which Demetrios had dismissed gathered to him and fought against him, and he fled and was routed.

56 And Tryphon took the beasts and gained possession of Antiocheia.

57 And Antiochos the younger wrote to Ionathes, saying, I confirm the high priesthood for you and appoint you over the four districts and to be among the friends of the king.

58 And he sent him golden vessels and a table service and gave him authority to drink from golden vessels and to be in purple and to have a golden clasp;

59 and he appointed Simon his brother commander from the ladder of Tyre as far as the borders of Egypt.

60 And Ionathan went out and was traveling beyond the river and in the cities, and the entire force of Syria gathered to him for alliance; and he came to Askalon, and those from the city met him gloriously.

61 And he departed from there to Gaza, and those from Gaza shut it, and he encamped around it and burned its surrounding towns with fire and plundered them.

62 And those from Gaza entreated Ionathan, and he gave them his right hand and took the sons of their rulers as hostages and sent them away to Ierousalem; and he passed through the country as far as Damascus.

63 And Ionathan heard that the rulers of Demetrios were present at Kedes in Galilee with a great force, wishing to remove him from his office.

64 And he met them, but left Simon his brother in the country.

65 And Simon encamped against Baithsoura and fought against it for many days and shut it in.

66 And they entreated him to receive right hands, and he gave them to them; and he expelled them from there and seized the city and placed a garrison over it.

67 And Ionathan and his camp encamped by the water of Gennesar; and they rose early in the morning to the plain of Asor.

68 And behold, the camp of foreigners met him in the plain, and they sent out an ambush against him in the mountains, but they themselves met him opposite.

69 And the ambushes rose from their places and joined battle.

70 And all those with Ionathes fled; not even one of them was left except Mattathias, the son of Apsalomos, and Ioudas, the son of Chalphi, rulers of the army of the forces.

71 And Ionathan tore his garments and placed earth on his head and prayed.

72 And he turned back toward them in battle and routed them, and they fled.

73 And those fleeing from him saw and returned to him and pursued with him as far as Kedes, as far as their camp, and encamped there.

74 And about three thousand men of the foreigners fell on that day. And Ionathan returned to Ierousalem.

Chapter 12

1 And Ionathan saw that the occasion was working with him, and he selected men and sent them to Rome to establish and renew the friendship with them.

2 And to the Spartans and other places he sent letters in the same way.

3 And they went to Rome and entered the council chamber and said, Ionathan the high priest and the nation of the Judeans sent us to renew for themselves the friendship and alliance as before.

4 And they gave them letters to those in each place, so that they might escort them to the land of Iouda with peace.

5 And this is the copy of the letters which Ionathan wrote to the Spartans:

6 Ionathan the high priest and the council of elders of the nation and the priests and the rest of the people of the Judeans to the Spartans, their brothers, greetings.

7 Even earlier letters were sent to Onias the high priest from Areios, who reigned among you, that you are our brothers, as the copy set out below shows.

8 And Onias received the man who had been sent gloriously and took the letters in which matters of alliance and friendship were made clear.

9 We therefore, being without need of these things, having as encouragement the holy books in our hands,

10 attempted to send to renew the brotherhood and friendship with you, so as not to become estranged from you; for many times have passed since you sent to us.

11 We therefore at every time, unceasingly, both at the feasts and on the other appropriate days, remember you at the sacrifices which we offer and in our prayers, as it is necessary and fitting to remember brothers.

12 And we rejoice at your glory.

13 But many afflictions and many wars surrounded us, and the kings around us fought against us.

14 We therefore did not wish to trouble you and our other allies and friends in these wars;

15 for we have the help from heaven helping us, and we were delivered from the enemies, and our enemies were humbled.

16 We therefore selected Noumenios, son of Antiochos, and Antipatros, son of Iason, and have sent them to the Romans to renew the former friendship and alliance with them.

17 We therefore also instructed them to go to you and greet you and deliver to you the letters from us concerning the renewal and our brotherhood.

18 And now you will do well by answering us concerning these things.

19 And this is the copy of the letters which they sent to Onias:

20 Areios, king of the Spartans, to Onias the great priest, greetings.

21 It was found in writing concerning both the Spartans and the Judeans that they are brothers and that they are of the race of Abraam.

22 And now, since we have learned these things, you will do well by writing to us concerning your peace,

23 and we also write back to you: Your livestock and your possessions are ours, and ours are yours. We therefore give orders that they report to you according to these things.

24 And Ionathan heard that the rulers of Demetrios had returned with a great force, greater than before, to fight against him.

25 And he departed from Ierousalem and met them in the country of Amathitis; for he did not give them an opportunity to enter his country.

26 And he sent spies into their camp, and they returned and reported to him that they were thus arranging to fall upon them at night.

27 But when the sun set, Ionathan ordered those with him to stay awake and be at their weapons, preparing for battle throughout the whole night, and he sent out advance guards around the camp.

28 And the adversaries heard that Ionathan and those with him were prepared for battle, and they feared and cowered in their heart and kindled fires in their camp.

29 But Ionathan and those with him did not know until morning, for they saw the lights burning.

30 And Ionathan pursued after them and did not overtake them, for they had crossed the Eleutheros river.

31 And Ionathan turned aside against the Arabs called the Zabadeans and struck them and took their spoils.

32 And he set out and came to Damascus and passed through all the country.

33 And Simon went out and passed through as far as Askalon and the nearby strongholds and turned aside to Ioppe and seized it beforehand;

34 for he heard that they wished to hand the stronghold over to those with Demetrios; and he placed a garrison there to guard it.

35 And Ionathan returned and assembled the elders of the people and deliberated with them about building strongholds in Judea

36 and raising the walls of Ierousalem further and raising a great height between the citadel and the city to separate it from the city, so that it might be alone, so that they might neither buy nor sell.

37 And they gathered to build the city, and part of the wall of the torrent on the east fell, and he repaired what is called Chaphenatha.

38 And Simon built Adida in Sephela and fortified it and installed doors and bars.

39 And Tryphon sought to reign over Asia and put on the diadem and stretch out a hand against Antiochos the king.

40 And he was wary lest Ionathan should not permit him and lest he fight against him, and sought to seize him to destroy him, and departed and came to Baithsan.

41 And Ionathan went out to meet him with forty thousand men selected for battle and came to Baithsan.

42 And Tryphon saw that he had come with a great force, and was wary of stretching out hands against him.

43 And he received him gloriously and commended him to all his friends and gave him gifts and ordered his friends and his forces to obey him as himself.

44 And he said to Ionathan, Why have you wearied all this people when no war has arisen for us?

45 And now send them to their houses, but select for yourself a few men who will be with you, and come with me to Ptolemais, and I shall hand it over to you, and the remaining strongholds and the remaining forces and all those over the affairs, and I shall turn back and depart; for I am here for this purpose.

46 And he trusted him and did as he said, and sent away the forces, and they departed to the land of Iouda.

47 But he left with himself three thousand men, of whom he left two thousand in Galilee, but a thousand went with him.

48 But when Ionathan entered Ptolemais, the people of Ptolemais shut the gates and seized him, and all those who had entered together with him they killed with the sword.

49 And Tryphon sent forces and cavalry into Galilee and the great plain to destroy all those with Ionathes.

50 And they learned that he had been seized and had perished, and those with him, and they encouraged one another and were marching closely together, ready for battle.

51 And those pursuing saw that it was a matter of life for them, and turned back.

52 And they all came with peace to the land of Iouda and mourned Ionathan and those with him and were greatly afraid; and all Israel mourned with great mourning.

53 And all the nations around them sought to wipe them out; for they said, They have no ruler or helper; now therefore let us fight them and remove their memorial from among human beings.

Chapter 13

1 And Simon heard that Tryphon had gathered a great force to come into the land of Iouda and wipe it out.

2 And he saw the people, that they were trembling and terrified, and went up to Ierousalem and gathered the people

3 and encouraged them and said to them, You yourselves know whatever I and my brothers and the house of my father have done for the laws and the holy places, and the wars and the straits which we have seen.

4 For this reason all my brothers perished for the sake of Israel, and I alone was left.

5 And now may it not happen to me to spare my life at any time of affliction; for I am not better than my brothers.

6 But I shall exact vengeance for my nation and for the holy places and for your wives and children, because all the nations have gathered to wipe us out because of enmity.

7 And the spirit of the people was rekindled as soon as they heard these words,

8 and they answered with a loud voice, saying, You are our leader in place of Ioudas and Ionathes your brother;

9 fight our war, and everything that you say to us we shall do.

10 And he gathered all the fighting men and hastened to finish the walls of Ierousalem and fortified it all around.

11 And he sent Ionathan, the son of Apsalomos, and with him a sufficient force to Ioppe, and he expelled those in it and remained there in it.

12 And Tryphon departed from Ptolemais with a great force to come into the land of Iouda, and Ionathan with him under guard.

13 But Simon encamped in Adida facing the plain.

14 And Tryphon learned that Simon had arisen in place of Ionathes his brother and that he was about to join battle with him, and sent ambassadors to him, saying,

15 On account of silver which Ionathan your brother owed to the royal treasury because of the offices he held, we are detaining him;

16 and now send a hundred talents of silver and two of his sons as hostages, so that when released he may not revolt from us, and we shall release him.

17 And Simon knew that they were speaking to him deceitfully, and he sends to collect the silver and the boys, lest he incur great enmity with the people,

18 saying, Because I did not send him the silver and the boys, he perished.

19 And he sent the boys and the hundred talents, and he proved false and did not release Ionathan.

20 And after these things Tryphon came to enter the country and wipe it out, and they went around by the road to Adora. And Simon and his camp marched opposite him to every place wherever he went.

21 But those from the citadel were sending ambassadors to Tryphon, urging him to come to them through the wilderness and send them food.

22 And Tryphon prepared all his cavalry to come, and on that night there was very much snow, and he did not come because of the snow. And he departed and came to Galaaditis.

23 But when he drew near Baskama, he killed Ionathan, and he was buried there.

24 And Tryphon turned back and departed to his own land.

25 And Simon sent and took the bones of Ionathes his brother and buried him in Modein, the city of his fathers.

26 And all Israel lamented him with a great lamentation and mourned him for many days.

27 And Simon built upon the tomb of his father and his brothers and raised it high to the sight with hewn stone at the back and the front.

28 And he erected seven pyramids, one opposite the other, for his father and his mother and his four brothers.

29 And for these he made constructions, setting great pillars around them, and on the pillars he made suits of armor for an everlasting name, and beside the suits of armor, carved ships to be seen by all those sailing the sea.

30 This is the tomb which he made in Modein, until this day.

31 But Tryphon dealt deceitfully with Antiochos the younger king and killed him

32 and reigned in his place and put on the diadem of Asia and inflicted a great blow upon the land.

33 And Simon built the strongholds of Judea and walled them around with high towers and great walls and gates and bars and placed food in the strongholds.

34 And Simon selected men and sent them to Demetrios the king to grant remission to the country, because all Tryphon's exactions were acts of plunder.

35 And Demetrios the king sent to him according to these words and answered him and wrote him such a letter:

36 King Demetrios to Simon, high priest and friend of kings, and to the elders and the nation of the Judeans, greetings.

37 We have received the golden crown and the palm branch which you sent and are ready to make great peace with you and write to those over the affairs to grant you the remissions.

38 And whatever we established with you stands, and let the strongholds which you built belong to you.

39 And we forgive errors of ignorance and the sins until today and the crown which you owed, and if anything else was taxed in Ierousalem, let it no longer be taxed.

40 And if any of you are fit to be enrolled among those around us, let them be enrolled, and let there be peace between us.

41 In the one hundred and seventieth year the yoke of the nations was lifted from Israel,

42 and the people began to write in the contracts and transactions: In the first year under Simon, great high priest and commander and leader of the Judeans.

43 In those days he encamped against Gazara and surrounded it with camps and made a siege tower and brought it up to the city and struck one tower and seized it.

44 And those in the siege tower leaped out into the city, and a great disturbance arose in the city.

45 And those in the city went up with wives and children onto the wall, having torn their garments, and cried out with a loud voice, requesting Simon to give them right hands,

46 and said, Do not deal with us according to our wickednesses, but according to your mercy.

47 And Simon relented toward them and did not fight them; and he expelled them from the city and cleansed the houses in which the idols were, and thus entered it, singing hymns and blessing.

48 And he expelled all uncleanness from it and settled in it men who would do the law and fortified it further and built himself a dwelling in it.

49 But those from the citadel in Ierousalem were prevented from going out and going into the country to buy and sell and became very hungry, and many of them perished by famine.

50 And they cried out to Simon to receive right hands, and he gave them to them; and he expelled them from there and cleansed the citadel from its defilements.

51 And they entered it on the twenty-third of the second month of the one hundred and seventy-first year, with praise and palm branches and with lyres and with cymbals and with harps and with hymns and with songs, because a great enemy had been crushed out of Israel.

52 And he established that this day should be observed yearly with gladness. And he further fortified the mountain of the temple beside the citadel; and he and those with him dwelt there.

53 And Simon saw Ioannes his son, that he was a man, and appointed him leader of all the forces; and he dwelt in Gazara.

Chapter 14

1 And in the one hundred and seventy-second year Demetrios the king gathered his forces and went to Media to draw help to himself, so that he might fight Tryphon.

2 And Arsakes, the king of Persia and Media, heard that Demetrios had entered his borders, and sent one of his rulers to seize him alive.

3 And he went and struck the camp of Demetrios and seized him and brought him to Arsakes, and he placed him under guard.

4 And the land of Iouda was quiet all the days of Simon, and he sought good things for his nation, and his authority and his glory pleased them all the days.

5 And with all his glory he took Ioppe as a harbor and made an entrance to the islands of the sea.

6 And he widened the borders for his nation and held possession of the country.

7 And he gathered many captives and became master of Gazara and Baithsoura and the citadel; and he removed the uncleannesses from it, and there was none opposing him.

8 And they were cultivating their land with peace, and the land gave its produce and the trees of the plains their fruit.

9 Elders sat in the broad streets; all were conversing about good things, and the young men put on glorious garments and robes of war.

10 He supplied food to the cities and furnished them with equipment for fortification, until the name of his glory was named as far as the end of the earth.

11 He made peace upon the land, and Israel rejoiced with great gladness.

12 And each sat under his vine and his fig tree, and there was none terrifying them.

13 And one fighting them ceased from the land, and the kings were crushed in those days.

14 And he strengthened all the lowly of his people; he sought out the law and removed every lawless and wicked person;

15 he glorified the holy places and multiplied the vessels of the holy places.

16 And it was heard in Rome that Ionathan had died, and as far as Sparta, and they were greatly grieved.

17 But when they heard that Simon his brother had become high priest in his place and that he held possession of the country and the cities in it,

18 they wrote to him on bronze tablets to renew with him the friendship and alliance which they had established with Ioudas and Ionathan his brothers.

19 And they were read before the assembly in Ierousalem.

20 And this is the copy of the letters which the Spartans sent: The rulers of the Spartans and the city to Simon the great priest and the elders and the priests and the rest of the people of the Judeans, their brothers, greetings.

21 The ambassadors sent to our people reported to us concerning your glory and honor, and we rejoiced at their arrival.

22 And we recorded what was said by them in the deliberations of the people thus: Noumenios, son of Antiochos, and Antipatros, son of Iason, ambassadors of the Judeans, came to us renewing the friendship with us.

23 And it pleased the people to receive the men gloriously and to place the copy of their words in the books designated for the people, so that the people of the Spartans might have a memorial. And they wrote the copy of these things to Simon the high priest.

24 After these things Simon sent Noumenios to Rome, having a great golden shield weighing a thousand minas, to establish the alliance with them.

25 But when the people heard these matters, they said, What thanks shall we repay Simon and his sons?

26 For he and his brothers and the house of his father gave strength and fought the enemies of Israel away from them and established freedom for it. And they recorded it on bronze tablets and placed it on pillars on Mount Sion.

27 And this is the copy of the writing: On the eighteenth of Eloul of the one hundred and seventy-second year — and this is the third year under Simon the great high priest in asaramel —

28 at a great gathering of priests and people and rulers of the nation and the elders of the country, he made it known to us;

29 since wars occurred often in the country, but Simon, son of Mattathias, a priest of the sons of Ioarib, and his brothers gave themselves to the danger and stood against the adversaries of their nation, so that their holy places and the law might stand, and with great glory they glorified their nation.

30 And Ionathan gathered their nation and became high priest for them and was added to his people,

31 and their enemies wished to enter their country and stretch out hands against their holy places;

32 then Simon stood against them and fought for his nation and expended much of his own money and supplied weapons to the men of the force of his nation and gave them pay

33 and fortified the cities of Judea and Baithsoura on the borders of Judea, where the weapons of the enemies had been previously, and placed a garrison there, Judean men.

34 And he fortified Ioppe by the sea and Gazara on the borders of Azotos, in which the enemies had previously dwelt, and settled Judeans there, and whatever was suitable for their restoration he placed in them.

35 And the people saw the faithfulness of Simon and the glory which he had resolved to bring to his nation, and appointed him their leader and high priest because he had done all these things, and the righteousness and the faithfulness which he maintained toward his nation, and he sought in every way to exalt his people.

36 And in his days it prospered in his hands for the nations to be removed from their country, and those in the city of Dauid in Ierousalem who had made themselves a citadel, from which they went out and defiled the surroundings of the holy places and inflicted a great blow upon purity.

37 And he settled Judean men in it and fortified it for the security of the country and the city and raised the walls of Ierousalem.

38 And King Demetrios confirmed the high priesthood for him according to these things

39 and made him one of his friends and glorified him with great glory.

40 For he heard that the Judeans had been called friends and allies and brothers by the Romans, and that they had met Simon's ambassadors gloriously,

41 and that the Judeans and the priests had consented that Simon should be their leader and high priest forever, until a faithful prophet should arise,

42 and that he should be commander over them, and that he should have care concerning the holy places, to appoint through himself those over their works and over the country and over the weapons and over the strongholds,

43 and that he should have care concerning the holy places, and that he should be obeyed by all, and that all contracts in the country should be written in his name, and that he should clothe himself in purple and wear gold;

44 and it shall not be permitted to anyone of the people and the priests to set aside any of these things or contradict what will be spoken by him or gather a gathering in the country without him or clothe himself in purple or fasten on a golden clasp;

45 but whoever acts contrary to these things or sets aside any of these things shall be liable.

46 And all the people consented to establish for Simon that he should act according to these words.

47 And Simon accepted and consented to serve as high priest and to be commander and ruler of the nation of the Judeans and priests and to preside over all.

48 And they said to place this writing on bronze tablets and erect them in the enclosure of the holy places in a conspicuous place,

49 but to place their copies in the treasury, so that Simon and his sons might have them.

Chapter 15

1 And Antiochos, son of Demetrios the king, sent letters from the islands of the sea to Simon, priest and ruler of the nation of the Judeans, and to the whole nation,

2 and they contained this form: King Antiochos to Simon the great priest and ruler of the nation and to the nation of the Judeans, greetings.

3 Since some pestilent men have gained possession of the kingdom of our fathers, but I wish to claim the kingdom, so that I may restore it as it was previously, and I have recruited a multitude of forces and prepared warships,

4 and I wish to land in the country, so that I may pursue those who have destroyed our country and those who have desolated many cities in my kingdom,

5 now therefore I confirm for you all the remissions which the kings before me granted you, and whatever other gifts they granted you.

6 And I have permitted you to make your own coinage, currency for your country,

7 and for Ierousalem and the holy places to be free; and all the weapons, as many as you prepared, and the strongholds which you built, which you possess, let them remain yours.

8 And every royal debt and the future royal dues, from now and for all time, let them be remitted to you;

9 but when we take hold of our kingdom, we shall glorify you and your nation and the temple with great glory, so that your glory may become manifest in all the earth.

10 In the one hundred and seventy-fourth year Antiochos went out into the land of his fathers, and all the forces came together to him, so that few were with Tryphon.

11 And Antiochos pursued him, and he came fleeing to Dora, which is by the sea;

12 for he knew that evils had gathered against him, and the forces had abandoned him.

13 And Antiochos encamped against Dora, and with him were one hundred and twenty thousand fighting men and eight thousand cavalry.

14 And he surrounded the city, and the ships joined from the sea, and he pressed the city from the land and the sea and permitted no one to go out or enter.

15 And Noumenios and those with him came from Rome, having letters to the kings and the countries in which these things had been written:

16 Leukios, consul of the Romans, to King Ptolemaios, greetings.

17 The ambassadors of the Judeans came to us, our friends and allies, renewing the friendship and alliance from the beginning, sent from Simon the high priest and the people of the Judeans,

18 and they brought a golden shield of a thousand minas.

19 It therefore pleased us to write to the kings and the countries that they should not seek evils for them and should not fight them and their cities and their country, and that they should not act as allies of those fighting against them.

20 And we decided to receive the shield from them.

21 If therefore any pestilent men have escaped from their country to you, hand them over to Simon the high priest, so that he may punish them according to their law.

22 And he wrote the same things to Demetrios the king and Attalos and Ariarathes and Arsakes

23 and to all the countries, and Sampsame and the Spartans and to Delos and to Myndos and to Sikyon and to Caria and to Samos and to Pamphylia and to Lycia and to Halikarnassos and to Rhodes and to Phaselis and to Kos and to Side and to Arados and Gortyna and Knidos and Cyprus and Kyrene.

24 And they wrote the copy of these things to Simon the high priest.

25 But Antiochos the king encamped against Dora a second time, continually bringing his hands against it and making engines, and shut Tryphon in from going out and entering.

26 And Simon sent him two thousand chosen men to act as his allies, and silver and gold and sufficient equipment.

27 And he did not wish to receive them, but set aside everything that he had previously agreed with him, and was becoming estranged from him.

28 And he sent to him Athenobios, one of his friends, to confer with him, saying, You hold possession of Ioppe and Gazara and the citadel in Ierousalem, cities of my kingdom.

29 You have desolated their borders and inflicted a great blow upon the land and become masters of many places in my kingdom.

30 Now therefore hand over the cities which you seized and the tributes of the places of which you became masters outside the borders of Judea.

31 But if not, give in their place five hundred talents of silver, and for the destruction which you have wrought and the tributes of the cities another five hundred talents; but if not, we shall come and wage war against you.

32 And Athenobios, the friend of the king, came to Ierousalem and saw Simon's glory and a sideboard with golden and silver vessels and a substantial retinue, and was astonished and reported to him the words of the king.

33 And Simon answered and said to him, We have neither taken foreign land nor gained possession of things belonging to others, but of the inheritance of our fathers; but it was seized by our enemies without judgment at a certain time;

34 but we, having an opportunity, hold fast to the inheritance of our fathers.

35 But concerning Ioppe and Gazara, which you demand, these inflicted a great blow upon the people and our country; for these we shall give a hundred talents.

36 And he did not answer him a word, but returned with wrath to the king and reported to him these words and Simon's glory and everything that he had seen, and the king was angry with great anger.

37 But Tryphon boarded a ship and fled to Orthosia.

38 And the king appointed Kendebaios chief commander of the coast and gave him infantry and cavalry forces;

39 and he ordered him to encamp facing Judea and ordered him to build Kedron and fortify the gates and to fight the people; but the king was pursuing Tryphon.

40 And Kendebaios arrived at Iamneia and began to provoke the people and enter Judea and take the people captive and murder.

41 And he built Kedron and stationed horsemen and forces there, so that going out they might traverse the roads of Judea, as the king had ordered him.

Chapter 16

1 And Ioannes went up from Gazara and reported to Simon his father what Kendebaios had carried out.

2 And Simon called his two elder sons, Ioudas and Ioannes, and said to them, I and my brothers and the house of my father have fought the wars of Israel from youth until today, and it prospered in our hands to deliver Israel many times;

3 but now I have grown old, and you, by mercy, are sufficient in years; take the place of me and my brother, and go out and fight on behalf of our nation, and may the help from heaven be with you.

4 And he selected from the country twenty thousand fighting men and horsemen, and they went against Kendebaios and slept in Modein.

5 And they arose in the morning and went into the plain, and behold, a great force to meet them, infantry and horsemen, and a torrent was between them.

6 And he encamped facing them, he and his people. And he saw the people afraid to cross the torrent and crossed first; and the men saw him and crossed behind him.

7 And he divided the people, and the horsemen in the midst of the infantry; but the cavalry of the adversaries was very numerous.

8 And they blew with the trumpets, and Kendebaios and his camp were routed, and many wounded fell from among them; but those left fled into the stronghold.

9 Then Ioudas, the brother of Ioannes, was wounded; but Ioannes pursued them until he came to Kedron, which he had built.

10 And they fled into the towers in the fields of Azotos, and he burned it with fire, and about two thousand men fell from among them. And he returned to Judea with peace.

11 And Ptolemaios, the son of Aboubos, had been appointed commander over the plain of Iericho and had much silver and gold;

12 for he was the son-in-law of the high priest.

13 And his heart was exalted, and he wished to gain possession of the country and was plotting deceitfully against Simon and his sons to remove them.

14 But Simon was visiting the cities in the country and attending to their care; and he went down to Iericho, he and Mattathias and Ioudas his sons, in the one hundred and seventy-seventh year, in the eleventh month [this is the month Sabat].

15 And the son of Aboubos received them deceitfully in the small stronghold called Dok, which he had built, and made them a great drinking feast and hid men there.

16 And when Simon and his sons became drunk, Ptolemaios and those with him rose and took their weapons and came in upon Simon at the banquet and killed him and his two sons and some of his servants.

17 And he committed great treachery and repaid evil things in place of good things.

18 And Ptolemaios wrote these things and sent them to the king, so that he might send him forces for help and hand over their country and the cities.

19 And he sent others to Gazara to remove Ioannes, and to the commanders of thousands he sent letters to come to him, so that he might give them silver and gold and gifts,

20 and he sent others to seize Ierousalem and the mountain of the temple.

21 And someone ran ahead and reported to Ioannes in Gazara that his father and his brothers had perished, and that he has sent to kill you also.

22 And on hearing it he was greatly astonished and seized the men who had come to destroy him and killed them; for he learned that they were seeking to destroy him.

23 And the remaining accounts of Ioannes and his wars and his deeds of courage which he courageously performed, and the building of the walls which he built, and his acts,

24 behold, these have been written in the book of the days of his high priesthood, from when he became high priest after his father.

2 Maccabees

Chapter 1

1 To the brothers, the Judeans in Egypt, greetings: the brothers, the Judeans in Ierosolyma and those in the country of Judea, good peace;

2 and may God do good to you and remember his covenant with Abraam and Isaak and Iakob, his faithful servants;

3 and may he give you all a heart to revere him and do his wills with a great heart and a willing soul;

4 and may he open your heart in his law and in the ordinances and make peace

5 and hear your petitions and be reconciled to you and not abandon you at an evil time.

6 And now we are here praying for you.

7 While Demetrios was reigning, in the one hundred and sixty-ninth year, we the Judeans have written to you in the affliction and in the crisis that came upon us in these years, since Iason and those with him revolted from the holy land and the kingdom

8 and burned the gateway and poured out innocent blood; and we entreated the Lord and were heard and offered sacrifice and fine flour and lit the lamps and set out the loaves.

9 And now, that you may observe the days of tent-pitching of the month Chaseleu. In the one hundred and eighty-eighth year.

10 Those in Ierosolyma and those in Judea and the council of elders and Ioudas to Aristoboulos, teacher of Ptolemaios the king, who is of the race of the anointed priests, and to the Judeans in Egypt, greetings and good health.

11 Having been saved by God from great dangers, we thank him greatly, as being arrayed against a king;

12 for he himself cast out those arrayed in the holy city.

13 For the leader, having come to Persia, and the force around him that seemed irresistible were cut down in the temple of Nanaia, the priests of Nanaia having used deception.

14 For Antiochos and the friends with him arrived at the place as though to dwell with her, for the sake of receiving the greater funds on account of a dowry,

15 and when the priests of Nanaion had set them out and he had approached with a few into the enclosure of the sacred precinct, having shut the temple as Antiochos entered,

16 having opened the hidden door of the paneled ceiling, throwing stones they struck down the leader, and having cut them into limbs and removed their heads, they threw them to those outside.

17 In all things blessed is our God, who handed over those who acted impiously.

18 Being about to observe the purification of the temple on the twenty-fifth of Chaseleu, we considered it necessary to explain to you, so that you yourselves also may observe the feast of tent-pitching and of the fire, when Neemias, who built both the temple and the altar, offered sacrifices.

19 For also when our fathers were being led to Persia, the pious priests of that time took some of the fire of the altar and secretly hid it in the hollow of a well having a dry condition, in which they secured it so that the place was unknown to all.

20 But after many years had passed, when it pleased God, Neemias, sent by the king of Persia, sent the descendants of the priests who had hidden it to fetch the fire; but when they explained to us that they had not found fire but thick water, he ordered them to draw it and bring it.

21 And when the things for the sacrifices had been brought up, Neemias ordered the priests to sprinkle with the water both the wood and the things laid upon it.

22 And when this happened and time passed and the sun shone out, having previously been clouded, a great fire was kindled, so that all marveled.

23 And the priests made prayer while the sacrifice was being consumed, both the priests and all, Ionathes beginning, and the rest responding, as did Neemias;

24 and the prayer had this form: Lord, Lord God, creator of all, fearful and strong and just and merciful, the only king and kind,

25 the only provider, the only just and almighty and eternal one, who saves Israel from every evil, who made the fathers chosen and sanctified them,

26 accept the sacrifice on behalf of all your people Israel and preserve your portion and sanctify it.

27 Gather together our dispersion, free those enslaved among the nations, look upon those despised and abhorred, and let the nations know that you are our God.

28 Torment those who oppress and outrage in arrogance.

29 Plant your people in your holy place, as Moyses said.

30 And the priests sang the hymns in accompaniment.

31 And when the things of the sacrifice had been consumed, Neemias also ordered the remaining water to be poured upon larger stones.

32 And when this happened, a flame was kindled; but when the light from the altar shone back, it was consumed.

33 And when the matter became manifest, it was also reported to the king of the Persians that in the place where the deported priests had hidden the fire the water appeared, from which those with Neemias also purified the things of the sacrifice,

34 and the king fenced it around and made it sacred, having examined the matter.

35 And from those whom the king favored he received many valuable things and shared them.

36 And those with Neemias called this nephthar, which is interpreted as purification; but it is called nephthai by most.

Chapter 2

1 And it is found in the records that Ieremias the prophet ordered those being deported to take some of the fire, as has been indicated,

2 and how the prophet instructed those being deported, having given them the law, that they should not forget the ordinances of the Lord, and that they should not be led astray in their minds on seeing golden and silver statues and the adornment around them;

3 and saying other such things, he exhorted that the law should not depart from their heart.

4 And it was in the writing how the prophet, a divine communication having come to him, ordered the tent and the ark to follow along; and how he went out to the mountain where Moyses had gone up and beheld the inheritance of God.

5 And Ieremias came and found a cavernous dwelling and brought the tent and the ark and the altar of incense in there and blocked the door.

6 And some of those following along approached to mark the way, and they could not find it.

7 But when Ieremias learned of it, he blamed them and said, The place shall also be unknown until God gathers a gathering of the people and becomes merciful;

8 and then the Lord shall show these things, and the glory of the Lord and the cloud shall be seen, as it was manifested in the time of Moyses, as Salomon also requested that the place should be greatly sanctified.

9 And it was also explained how, having wisdom, he offered a sacrifice of dedication and of the completion of the temple.

10 Just as Moyses also prayed to the Lord, and fire came down from heaven and consumed the things of the sacrifice, so Salomon also prayed, and the fire came down and consumed the whole burnt offerings.

11 And Moyses said, Because the offering concerning sin was not eaten, it was consumed.

12 In the same way Salomon also observed the eight days.

13 And in the records and in the memoirs concerning Neemias the same things were also related, and how, founding a library, he gathered the books concerning the kings and prophets and those of Dauid and letters of kings concerning votive offerings.

14 And in the same way Ioudas also gathered all the things scattered because of the war that had occurred for us, and they are with us;

15 if therefore you have need of them, send those who will carry them away for you.

16 Being about to observe the purification, therefore, we wrote to you; you will therefore do well by observing the days.

17 And God, who saved all his people and restored to all the inheritance and the kingship and the priesthood and the sanctification,

18 as he promised through the law; for we hope in God that he will quickly have mercy on us and gather us from what is under heaven into the holy place; for he delivered us from great evils and purified the place.

19 And the matters concerning Ioudas Makkabaios and his brothers and the purification of the very great temple and the dedication of the altar,

20 and further the wars against Antiochos the Illustrious and his son Eupator,

21 and the manifestations from heaven that occurred for those who zealously performed courageous deeds on behalf of Judaism, so that, being few, they plundered the whole country and pursued the barbarian multitudes,

22 and recovered the temple renowned throughout the whole inhabited world and freed the city and restored the laws that were about to be dissolved, the Lord having become merciful to them with all gentleness,

23 set forth by Iason of Kyrene in five books, we shall attempt to abridge in one composition.

24 For seeing the mass of the numbers and the existing difficulty for those wishing to enter into the narratives of the history because of the multitude of the material,

25 we took care for entertainment for those wishing to read, and for ease for those eager to take it up through memory, and for benefit for all those encountering it.

26 And for us who have accepted the hardship of the abridgment it is not easy, but the undertaking is one of sweat and sleeplessness,

27 just as it is not easy for one preparing a banquet and seeking the benefit of others; nevertheless, for the gratitude of the many we shall gladly bear the hardship,

28 leaving the exact examination of each matter to the author, but laboring to follow the outlines of the abridgment.

29 For just as the architect of a new house must take care of the whole foundation, but the one undertaking encaustic work and painting must examine the things suitable for adornment, so I think it is also with us.

30 To enter in and make a circuit of accounts and inquire minutely into particulars belongs to the originator of the history;

31 but to pursue conciseness of expression and decline the elaborate treatment of the subject must be allowed to the one making the recasting.

32 From here therefore let us begin the narrative, having added this much to what was said before; for it is foolish to multiply what is before the history but abridge the history.

Chapter 3

1 While the holy city was inhabited with all peace and the laws were maintained most excellently because of both the piety and hatred of wickedness of Onias the high priest,

2 it happened that even the kings themselves honored the place and glorified the temple with the finest gifts,

3 so that even Seleukos, the king of Asia, supplied from his own revenues all the expenses falling due for the services of the sacrifices.

4 But a certain Simon of the tribe of Beniamin, appointed superintendent of the temple, quarreled with the high priest concerning the supervision of the market in the city;

5 and being unable to overcome Onias, he came to Apollonios, son of Tharseas, who at that time was commander of Coele Syria and Phoenicia,

6 and reported that the treasury in Ierosolyma was full of unspeakable wealth, so that the multitude of valuables was innumerable, and that they did not belong to the account of the sacrifices, but that it was possible for these things to fall under the king's authority.

7 And Apollonios met with the king and informed him concerning the funds reported to him; and he selected Heliodoros, who was over the affairs, and sent him, giving orders to carry away the aforementioned funds.

8 And immediately Heliodoros undertook the journey, ostensibly to visit the cities in Coele Syria and Phoenicia, but in reality to fulfill the king's intention.

9 And arriving in Ierosolyma and being kindly received by the high priest of the city, he related the report that had been made and explained why he was present; and he inquired whether these things were actually so.

10 And the high priest pointed out that they were deposits of both widows and orphans,

11 and some also of Hyrkanos, son of Tobias, a man placed in very great eminence — thus the impious Simon was misrepresenting it — and the whole was four hundred talents of silver and two hundred of gold;

12 and that it was entirely impossible that those who had trusted in the holiness of the place and in the dignity and inviolability of the temple honored throughout the whole world should be wronged.

13 But Heliodoros, because of the royal orders he held, said that these things must in every case be taken up into the royal treasury.

14 And having appointed a day, he entered to manage the inspection concerning these things; and there was no small anguish throughout the whole city.

15 And the priests, having cast themselves before the altar in their priestly robes, called toward heaven upon the one who had legislated concerning a deposit, to preserve these things safe for those who had deposited them.

16 And to see the appearance of the high priest was to be wounded in mind; for his face and the alteration of his complexion manifested the anguish of his soul;

17 for a certain dread and trembling of body had poured around the man, through which the pain present in his heart became evident to those beholding him.

18 And further they sprang out of the houses in crowds for a supplication of all the people, because the place was about to come into contempt.

19 And the women, girded with sackcloth beneath their breasts, filled the roads; and of the secluded virgins, some ran together to the gateways, others to the walls, and some leaned out through the windows;

20 and all, stretching their hands toward heaven, made their entreaty;

21 and the mingled prostration of the multitude and the expectation of the greatly anguished high priest were to be pitied.

22 They therefore called upon the all-powerful Lord to preserve the entrusted things safe for those who had entrusted them, with all security.

23 But Heliodoros carried out what had been decided.

24 And when he was already present there with the bodyguards at the treasury, the ruler of the spirits and of all authority made a great manifestation, so that all those who had dared to come together, struck by the power of God, turned to faintness and cowardice;

25 for a certain horse appeared to them, having a fearful rider and adorned with most beautiful harness, and rushing forcefully it struck at Heliodoros with its front hoofs; and the one seated upon it appeared to have golden armor.

26 And two other young men appeared to him, outstanding in strength and most beautiful in glory and splendid in dress, who also stood around him on either side and scourged him unceasingly, casting many blows upon him.

27 And when he suddenly fell to the ground and was enveloped in great darkness, they seized him and placed him on a litter,

28 and carried the one who had just entered the aforementioned treasury with a great retinue and all his bodyguard, now helpless to himself, having manifestly recognized the power of God.

29 And he lay cast down because of the divine working, speechless and deprived of all hope and salvation,

30 but they blessed the Lord who wondrously glorified his own place, and the temple, which a little before had been full of dread and disturbance, was filled with joy and gladness when the almighty Lord appeared.

31 And quickly some of Heliodoros' associates requested Onias to call upon the Most High and grant life to the one lying utterly at his last breath.

32 And the high priest, becoming apprehensive lest the king should form an opinion that some wrongdoing concerning Heliodoros had been carried out by the Judeans, offered a sacrifice for the man's salvation.

33 And while the high priest made the atonement, the same young men appeared again to Heliodoros, clothed in the same garments, and stood and said, Have much gratitude to Onias the high priest, for because of him the Lord has granted you life;

34 but you, having been scourged from heaven, proclaim to all the magnificent might of God. And having said these things, they became invisible.

35 And Heliodoros offered a sacrifice to the Lord and vowed very great vows to the one who had preserved his life, and greeted Onias and broke camp to go to the king.

36 And he testified to all the works of the greatest God which he had beheld with his eyes.

37 And when the king asked Heliodoros what sort of man would be suitable to be sent once again to Ierosolyma, he said,

38 If you have any enemy or plotter against your affairs, send him there, and you will receive him scourged, if indeed he is even saved, because some power of God is truly about the place;

39 for the one who himself has his dwelling in heaven is overseer and helper of that place, and strikes and destroys those arriving to do harm.

40 And the matters concerning Heliodoros and the preservation of the treasury proceeded thus.

Chapter 4

1 But the aforementioned Simon, who had become informer concerning the funds and the fatherland, spoke evil of Onias, as though he himself had shaken Heliodoros and had become the maker of the evils,

2 and he dared to call the benefactor of the city and guardian of his fellow nationals and zealot for the laws a plotter against the affairs.

3 And when the enmity advanced so far that even murders were being carried out through one of those approved by Simon,

4 Onias, seeing the severity of the rivalry and Apollonios, son of Menestheus, the commander of Coele Syria and Phoenicia, increasing Simon's wickedness,

5 went to the king, becoming no accuser of the citizens, but looking to the advantage, common and individual, of the whole multitude;

6 for he saw that without royal care it was impossible for affairs still to obtain peace and that Simon would take no pause from his folly.

7 But when Seleukos departed this life and Antiochos, called the Illustrious, received the kingdom, Iason, the brother of Onias, fraudulently supplanted him in the high priesthood,

8 promising the king in an interview three hundred and sixty talents of silver and eighty talents from some other revenue.

9 And besides these he promised to pay another hundred and fifty, if through his authority he were permitted to establish a gymnasium and an institution for youths and register those in Ierosolyma as Antiochenes.

10 And when the king consented and he took hold of the office, he immediately shifted his fellow tribesmen to the Greek character.

11 And setting aside the benevolent royal concessions established for the Judeans through Ioannes, the father of Eupolemos, who had made the embassy for friendship and alliance with the Romans, and dissolving the lawful civic institutions, he introduced unlawful customs.

12 For he gladly established a gymnasium beneath the citadel itself, and subjecting the best of the youths, brought them under the broad-brimmed hat.

13 And there was thus a certain height of Hellenism and an advance of foreign ways because of the surpassing impurity of the impious Iason, who was no high priest,

14 so that the priests were no longer eager for the services of the altar, but despising the temple and neglecting the sacrifices, they hurried to participate in the unlawful provision in the wrestling ground after the summons of the discus,

15 and setting the ancestral honors at nothing, but considering the Greek glories most beautiful.

16 Because of these things a severe predicament also encompassed them, and those whose ways they envied and to whom they wished to be entirely assimilated, these they had as enemies and punishers;

17 for to act impiously toward the divine laws is no light thing, but the following time will show these things.

18 And when the five-year games were being held in Tyre and the king was present,

19 the polluted Iason sent sacred envoys, being Antiochenes from Ierosolyma, carrying three hundred drachmas of silver for the sacrifice of Herakles, which those carrying them also requested not to use for sacrifice, because it was not fitting, but to put toward another expense.

20 These things therefore were assigned by the sender to the sacrifice of Herakles, but because of those carrying them to the construction of the triremes.

21 And when Apollonios, son of Menestheus, had been sent into Egypt for the first enthronement ceremonies of King Philometor, Antiochos learned that he had become estranged from his affairs and took care for his own security; therefore, arriving at Ioppe, he came to Ierosolyma.

22 And being magnificently received by Iason and the city, he was welcomed with torch-bearing and shouts; then thus he marched to camp in Phoenicia.

23 And after a period of three years Iason sent Menelaos, brother of the previously mentioned Simon, carrying the funds to the king and to complete reports concerning necessary affairs.

24 And he, being introduced to the king and glorifying him with the appearance of authority, brought the high priesthood to himself, exceeding Iason by three hundred talents of silver.

25 And having received the royal orders, he arrived, bringing nothing worthy of the high priesthood, but having the passions of a cruel tyrant and the rages of a barbarous beast.

26 And Iason, who had fraudulently supplanted his own brother, being fraudulently supplanted by another, was driven as a fugitive into the Ammanite country.

27 But Menelaos held the office, yet was not keeping anything in order concerning the funds promised to the king;

28 and Sostratos, the governor of the citadel, was demanding payment, for the collection of the funds belonged to him; for this reason the two were summoned by the king,

29 and Menelaos left Lysimachos his own brother as successor in the high priesthood, but Sostratos left Krates, who was over the Cyprians.

30 And while such things were taking place, it happened that the people of Tarsos and Mallos were revolting because they had been given as a gift to Antiochis, the king's concubine.

31 The king therefore came quickly to settle the affairs, leaving Andronikos, one of those in high rank, as his deputy.

32 But Menelaos, thinking he had obtained a favorable opportunity, stole some of the golden vessels of the temple and presented them to Andronikos, and had sold others both to Tyre and to the surrounding cities.

33 And Onias, having learned these things clearly, exposed them, having withdrawn into a place of asylum at Daphne, situated near Antiocheia.

34 Therefore Menelaos took Andronikos privately and exhorted him to subdue Onias; and he came to Onias, having been persuaded to deceit, and greeted him, giving his right hand with oaths, and although under suspicion, persuaded him to come out of the asylum, and immediately shut him out of life, without reverence for justice.

35 For this reason not only Judeans but also many of the other nations were indignant and distressed at the unjust murder of the man.

36 And when the king returned from the places in Cilicia, the Judeans in the city petitioned concerning the unreasonable killing of Onias, the Greeks also sharing their hatred of the wickedness.

37 Antiochos therefore was grieved in soul and turned to mercy and wept because of the moderation and great good order of the departed,

38 and inflamed with anger, immediately removed Andronikos' purple and tore his tunics and led him around through the whole city to the very place where he had acted impiously against Onias; there he removed the bloodstained man from life, the Lord having repaid him the fitting punishment.

39 And when many temple robberies had been committed in the city by Lysimachos with Menelaos' consent, and the report had spread abroad, the multitude gathered against Lysimachos, many golden vessels having already been carried away.

40 And when the crowds were rising and filling with anger, Lysimachos armed about three thousand and began unjust violence, a certain Auranos leading, advanced in age but no less also in folly;

41 and seeing Lysimachos' attack, some seized stones, others thick pieces of wood, and some grasped handfuls of the ashes lying nearby, and hurled them indiscriminately at those with Lysimachos;

42 for this reason they made many of them wounded and also struck some down and drove all into flight, but the temple robber himself they subdued beside the treasury.

43 And concerning these things a trial arose against Menelaos.

44 And when the king arrived in Tyre, the three men sent by the council of elders made their plea before him.

45 But Menelaos, already defeated, promised sufficient money to Ptolemaios, son of Dorymenes, to persuade the king.

46 Therefore Ptolemaios took the king aside into a certain colonnade as though to refresh him, and changed his mind,

47 and he released Menelaos, the cause of the whole wickedness, from the accusations, but upon the wretched men, who, even if they had pleaded before Scythians, would have been released uncondemned, upon these he pronounced death.

48 Quickly therefore those who had spoken for the city and peoples and the sacred vessels underwent the unjust penalty.

49 For this reason even the Tyrians, hating the wickedness, magnificently supplied the things for their burial.

50 But Menelaos, because of the greed of those in power, remained in office, growing in wickedness, having become a great plotter against the citizens.

Chapter 5

1 And about this time Antiochos undertook the second expedition into Egypt.

2 And it happened throughout the whole city for almost forty days that horsemen appeared running through the air, having robes interwoven with gold and armed with lances in companies, and drawings of swords,

3 and squadrons of horses arrayed and assaults taking place and charges of both sides and movements of shields and multitudes of spears and discharges of missiles and flashes of golden adornments and armor of every kind.

4 Therefore all requested that the manifestation should have occurred for good.

5 And when a false rumor arose that Antiochos had departed this life, Iason took no fewer than a thousand and suddenly carried out an attack upon the city; and when those upon the wall were driven together and the city was finally already being seized, Menelaos fled into the citadel.

6 And Iason slaughtered his own citizens unsparingly, not considering that success against his kinsmen was the greatest misfortune, but thinking he was erecting trophies over enemies and not fellow nationals.

7 He did not take hold of the office, but receiving shame as the end of his plot, departed again as a fugitive into Ammanitis.

8 Finally therefore he met an evil end. Accused before Aretas, the ruler of the Arabs, fleeing from city to city, pursued by all, hated as an apostate from the laws and abhorred as executioner of his fatherland and citizens, he was cast out into Egypt,

9 and he who had alienated many from their fatherland perished in a foreign land, having sailed to the Lakedaimonians as though to obtain shelter because of their kinship.

10 And he who had cast out a multitude unburied became unmourned and shared in no burial whatsoever or ancestral tomb.

11 And when reports concerning what had happened reached the king, he supposed that Judea was revolting; therefore, setting out from Egypt, made beastlike in soul, he took the city by the spear

12 and ordered the soldiers to cut down unsparingly those they encountered and slaughter those going up into the houses.

13 And there was killing of young and elderly, destruction of the immature and women and children, slaughter of virgins and infants.

14 And eighty thousand were destroyed in the whole three days, forty thousand in attacks of hands, and no fewer than those slaughtered were sold.

15 And not satisfied with these things, he dared to enter the holiest temple of all the earth, having as guide Menelaos, who had become betrayer of both the laws and the fatherland,

16 and taking the sacred vessels with his polluted hands and dragging together with his profane hands the things dedicated by other kings for the increase and glory and honor of the place.

17 And Antiochos was exalted in mind, not seeing that because of the sins of those dwelling in the city the Master had been briefly angered, therefore neglect had occurred concerning the place.

18 But if it had not happened to be involved in many sins, as was Heliodoros, sent by Seleukos the king for the inspection of the treasury, this man, advancing, would immediately have been scourged and overturned from his audacity.

19 But the Lord did not choose the nation because of the place, but the place because of the nation.

20 Therefore the place itself also, having shared in the nation's misfortunes, partook in benefits that occurred afterward, and what had been abandoned in the anger of the Almighty was again restored with all glory in the reconciliation of the great Master.

21 Antiochos therefore, having carried away eighteen hundred talents from the temple, departed quickly into Antiocheia, supposing in his arrogance that he could make the land navigable and the open sea walkable because of the exaltation of his heart.

22 And he also left overseers to afflict the race: in Ierosolyma, Philip, a Phrygian by race, but having a character more barbarous than the one who appointed him,

23 and in Garizin, Andronikos, and besides these Menelaos, who exalted himself against the citizens worst of the others, and having a hateful disposition toward the Judean citizens.

24 And he sent Apollonios, the commander of the Mysians, with an army of twenty-two thousand, ordering him to slaughter all those of full age, but sell the women and the younger ones.

25 And he arrived in Ierosolyma and pretended to be peaceful, and waited until the holy day of the sabbath, and finding the Judeans inactive, ordered those under him to parade under arms

26 and stabbed all those who had come out to view it, and rushing into the city with the weapons, laid low considerable multitudes.

27 But Ioudas, also called Makkabaios, being one of about ten and withdrawing into the wilderness, lived in the mountains in the manner of beasts with those with him, and they continued eating vegetation as food, so as not to partake of the pollution.

Chapter 6

1 And after no long time the king sent out an elderly Athenian to compel the Judeans to depart from the ancestral laws and not conduct their life by the laws of God,

2 and also to pollute the temple in Ierosolyma and name it after Olympian Zeus, and the one in Garizin, as those dwelling in the place happened to be, after Zeus of Strangers.

3 And the intensification of the wickedness was severe and altogether grievous.

4 For the temple was filled with debauchery and revels by the nations, who dallied with courtesans and had intercourse with women in the sacred enclosures, and further brought inside things that were not fitting.

5 And the altar was filled with unlawful things forbidden by the laws.

6 And it was not possible to keep the sabbath or preserve ancestral feasts or simply confess oneself to be a Judean,

7 and they were led with bitter compulsion to eat sacrificial entrails on the monthly birthday of the king, and when the feast of Dionysia occurred, they were compelled to carry ivy and march in procession for Dionysos.

8 And a decree went out to the neighboring Greek cities, Ptolemaios having proposed that they conduct the same treatment against the Judeans and make them eat sacrificial entrails,

9 but slaughter those not choosing to change over to Greek ways. It was therefore possible to see the present misery.

10 For two women were brought up who had circumcised their children; and having hung the infants from their breasts and publicly led the women around the city, they hurled them down from the wall.

11 And others who had run together into the nearby caves secretly to observe the seventh day were reported to Philip and burned together, because they scrupled to help themselves in view of the dignity of the most solemn day.

12 I therefore exhort those encountering this book not to shrink back because of the calamities, but to consider the punishments to be for the discipline of our race, not for destruction;

13 for indeed, that those acting impiously are not permitted a long time, but immediately fall into penalties, is a sign of great beneficence.

14 For the Master did not judge that it should also be with us as with the other nations, for whom he waits patiently until they reach the fullness of sins, to punish them,

15 so that he may not afterward punish us when we have reached the completion of our sins.

16 Therefore he never withdraws mercy from us, but while disciplining through calamity, does not abandon his own people.

17 But let these things have been said by us as a reminder; and through a few words we must come to the narrative.

18 A certain Eleazar, one of the foremost scribes, a man already advanced in age and most beautiful in facial appearance, was compelled, with mouth gaping, to eat pork.

19 But he, embracing death with good fame rather than life with pollution, voluntarily advanced to the torture rack,

20 but having spat it out, in the way in which those who endure must approach, resisting the tasting of things not lawful because of affection for life.

21 And those appointed over the unlawful eating of sacrificial entrails, because of their acquaintance with the man from earlier times, took him aside privately and exhorted him to bring meat which it was fitting for him to use, prepared by himself, but to pretend to be eating the meat from the sacrifice ordered by the king,

22 so that by doing this he might be released from death and because of his old friendship with them obtain humane treatment.

23 But he took up a noble resolve worthy of his age and the eminence of his old age and the acquired and conspicuous gray hair and his most excellent conduct from childhood, but rather of the holy and God-established legislation, and accordingly declared quickly, saying to send him onward to Hades.

24 For it is not worthy of our age to pretend, so that many of the young, supposing that the ninety-year-old Eleazar has changed over to foreign ways,

25 may themselves also be led astray because of me through my pretense and for the sake of a little and momentary life, and I acquire pollution and a stain upon my old age.

26 For even if for the present I escape the punishment from human beings, yet neither living nor dead shall I escape the hands of the Almighty.

27 Therefore, courageously departing this life now, I shall appear worthy of my old age,

28 and having left the young a noble example to die eagerly and nobly for the solemn and holy laws. And having said so much, he immediately came to the torture rack.

29 And those leading him changed their goodwill toward him of a little before into ill will, because the aforementioned words, as they supposed, were madness,

30 and being about to die from the blows, he groaned and said, It is manifest to the Lord who has holy knowledge that, though able to be released from death, I endure severe pains in body while being scourged, but in soul I gladly suffer these things because of fear of him.

31 And he therefore departed in this way, having left his own death as an example of nobility and a memorial of virtue, not only to the young but also to most of the nation.

Chapter 7

1 And it also happened that seven brothers with their mother were seized and compelled by the king to partake of unlawful pork, being tortured with whips and sinews.

2 And one of them became spokesman and said thus, What are you going to ask and learn from us? For we are ready to die rather than transgress the ancestral laws.

3 And the king became furious and ordered pans and cauldrons to be heated.

4 And when they were immediately heated, he ordered the tongue of the one who had become their spokesman to be cut out and, after scalping him, to cut off his extremities, the remaining brothers and the mother looking on.

5 And when he had become entirely helpless, he ordered him to be brought to the fire while breathing and fried in the pan. And as the vapor from the pan spread far, they with their mother exhorted one another to die nobly, saying thus,

6 The Lord God watches and truly has compassion upon us, as Moyses explained through the song that testifies against them to their face, saying, And he shall have compassion upon his servants.

7 And when the first departed in this way, they led the second to the mockery, and having torn off the skin of his head with the hair, asked, Will you eat before your body is punished limb by limb?

8 But he answered in the ancestral tongue and said, No. Therefore this one also received the torture in turn, as the first.

9 And coming to his last breath, he said, You, accursed one, release us from the present life, but the king of the world will raise us, who die for his laws, to an eternal revival of life.

10 And after him the third was mocked, and when asked for his tongue, quickly put it forward and confidently stretched out his hands

11 and nobly said, From heaven I possess these, and because of his laws I disregard these, and from him I hope to receive these again;

12 so that the king himself and those with him were astonished at the soul of the young man, how he counted the pains as nothing.

13 And when this one also departed, they tortured the fourth in the same way, maltreating him.

14 And coming near death, he said thus, It is preferable, departing by human hands, to await the hopes from God, to be raised again by him; for you there shall be no resurrection to life.

15 And next they brought the fifth and maltreated him.

16 And looking toward him he said, Having authority among human beings, though corruptible, you do what you wish; but do not think that our race has been abandoned by God;

17 but you wait and behold his magnificent might, how he will torment you and your seed.

18 And after him they led the sixth, and being about to die, he said, Do not be deceived in vain, for we suffer these things because of ourselves, having sinned against our own God; things worthy of wonder have happened;

19 but do not suppose that you will be guiltless, having undertaken to fight God.

20 And the mother was exceedingly marvelous and worthy of good remembrance, who, seeing seven sons perish within the time of one day, bore it courageously because of her hopes in the Lord.

21 And she exhorted each of them in the ancestral tongue, filled with noble resolve and stirring her womanly reasoning with manly spirit, saying to them,

22 I do not know how you appeared in my womb, nor did I grant you spirit and life, and I did not arrange the composition of each;

23 therefore the creator of the world, who formed the origin of humankind and devised the origin of all things, also gives spirit and life back to you again with mercy, as you now disregard yourselves because of his laws.

24 But Antiochos, thinking he was despised and suspecting the reproachful voice, while the youngest was still alive, made his exhortation not only through words, but also assured through oaths that he would both enrich him and make him blessed if he changed from the ancestral ways, and would have him as a friend and entrust him with offices.

25 But when the young man paid no attention at all, the king summoned the mother and urged her to become an adviser to the youth for his salvation.

26 And when he had urged her greatly, she accepted to persuade her son;

27 but bending toward him, mocking the cruel tyrant, she said thus in the ancestral tongue, Son, have mercy on me, who carried you in the womb nine months and nursed you three years and raised you and brought you to this age and nourished you.

28 I request you, child, to look up to heaven and the earth and see all things in them and know that God made them not out of existing things, and the race of human beings comes into being thus.

29 Do not fear this executioner, but becoming worthy of your brothers, accept death, so that in mercy I may receive you with your brothers.

30 And while she was still finishing, the young man said, Whom are you waiting for? I do not obey the command of the king, but I obey the ordinance of the law given to our fathers through Moyses.

31 But you, having become inventor of every wickedness against the Hebrews, shall certainly not escape the hands of God.

32 For we suffer because of our own sins.

33 But if for rebuke and discipline our living Lord has been briefly angered, he will also again be reconciled to his own servants.

34 But you, unholy one and most polluted of all human beings, do not vainly exalt yourself, raging with uncertain hopes, raising a hand against the heavenly children;

35 for you have not yet escaped the judgment of the almighty, overseeing God.

36 For now our brothers, having borne a brief pain, have fallen under God's covenant of perpetual life; but you, by God's judgment, shall bear the just penalties of your arrogance.

37 But I, like the brothers, surrender both body and soul for the ancestral laws, calling upon God to become quickly merciful to the nation and for you, through trials and scourges, to confess that he alone is God,

38 and in me and my brothers to stop the anger of the Almighty which has justly been brought upon our whole race.

39 And the king became furious and treated this one worse than the others, bearing the mockery bitterly.

40 And this one therefore departed pure, trusting entirely in the Lord.

41 And last after the sons the mother died.

42 Let the matters concerning the eating of sacrificial entrails and the surpassing tortures therefore have been set forth to this extent.

Chapter 8

1 But Ioudas, also called Makkabaios, and those with him secretly entered the villages and called their kinsmen, and taking along those who had remained in Judaism, gathered about six thousand.

2 And they called upon the Lord to look upon the people trampled by all, and also to pity the temple profaned by the impious men,

3 and also to have mercy on the city being destroyed and about to become level with the ground, and to hear the blood crying out to him,

4 and also to remember the unlawful destruction of the sinless infants, and concerning the blasphemies that had occurred against his name, and to hate the wickedness.

5 And Makkabaios, having formed a body, was already becoming irresistible to the nations, the Lord's anger having turned to mercy.

6 And coming unexpectedly, he burned cities and villages, and taking the advantageous places and routing not a few of the enemies,

7 he especially took the nights as fellow workers for such attacks. And talk of his manliness resounded everywhere.

8 But Philip, seeing the man gradually coming to advancement and progressing more frequently in successes, wrote to Ptolemaios, the commander of Coele Syria and Phoenicia, to help the king's affairs.

9 And he quickly selected Nikanor, son of Patroklos, one of the first friends, and sent him, subjecting to him nations of all tribes, no fewer than twenty thousand, to remove the entire race of Judea; and he associated with him also Gorgias, a commander and man having experience in warlike affairs.

10 And Nikanor determined to fulfill the tribute for the king to the Romans, being two thousand talents, from the captivity of the Judeans.

11 And immediately he sent to the coastal cities, inviting the purchase of Judean bodies, promising to give ninety bodies for a talent, not expecting the judgment from the Almighty that was about to follow upon him.

12 And news concerning Nikanor's advance reached Ioudas, and when he communicated the presence of the army to those with him,

13 those acting cowardly and distrusting God's judgment were slipping away and removing themselves.

14 But the others sold all the things remaining, and together requested the Lord to deliver those who had been sold by the impious Nikanor before meeting him;

15 and if not because of themselves, yet because of the covenants with their fathers and because of the invocation upon them of his solemn and magnificent name.

16 And Makkabaios gathered those around him, being six thousand in number, and exhorted them not to be struck with terror by the enemies or fear the great multitude of the nations unjustly coming against them, but to contend nobly,

17 having before their eyes the outrage lawlessly carried out by them against the holy place and the maltreatment of the mocked city, and further the dissolution of the ancestral civic order.

18 For they trust in weapons and audacities together, he said, but we trust in the almighty God, who is able to cast down both those coming against us and the whole world with one nod.

19 And further recounting to them also the aids that had occurred in the time of the ancestors and that in the time of Sennacherim, how one hundred and eighty-five thousand perished,

20 and the battle against the Galatians that occurred in Babylonia, how the whole number who came to the affair was eight thousand with four thousand Macedonians, and when the Macedonians were at a loss, the eight thousand destroyed the one hundred and twenty thousand because of the help that came to them from heaven, and received much benefit.

21 By these things he made them confident and ready to die for the laws and the fatherland, and made the army into four parts.

22 And appointing his brothers, Simon and Iosepos and Ionathes, to lead each division, subjecting fifteen hundred to each,

23 and further also Eleazar, having read aloud the sacred book and given the watchword of God's help, himself leading the first company, he joined battle with Nikanor.

24 And when the Almighty became their ally, they slaughtered more than nine thousand of the enemies and made the greater part of Nikanor's army wounded and disabled in their limbs, and compelled all to flee.

25 And they took the money of those who had come for their purchase; and having pursued them together for a considerable distance, they returned, being constrained by the hour;

26 for it was the day before the sabbath, for which reason they did not prolong the pursuit of them.

27 And having collected their weapons and stripped the spoils from the enemies, they occupied themselves with the sabbath, abundantly blessing and giving thanks to the Lord who had saved them for this day, having appointed for them a beginning of mercy.

28 And after the sabbath, having apportioned some of the spoils to those maltreated and to the widows and orphans, they themselves and the children divided the rest.

29 And having accomplished these things and made a common supplication, they requested the merciful Lord to be entirely reconciled to his own servants.

30 And contending with those around Timotheos and Bakchides, they killed more than twenty thousand of them and gained very firm possession of high strongholds and divided much booty, making themselves and those maltreated and orphans and widows and further also elders equal sharers.

31 And having carefully collected their own weapons, they deposited everything in the advantageous places, but brought the rest of the spoils to Ierosolyma.

32 And they killed the tribal leader of those around Timotheos, a most unholy man who had greatly grieved the Judeans.

33 And celebrating victory in the fatherland, they set fire to those who had burned the sacred gateways and to Kallisthenes, who had fled into one small house, and he received the reward worthy of his impiety.

34 But the thrice-accursed Nikanor, who had brought the thousand merchants for the sale of the Judeans,

35 humbled by those considered by him to be least, through the Lord's help, put off his glorious clothing and, making himself solitary, came through the inland country to Antiocheia in the manner of a runaway, having been supremely fortunate at the destruction of the army.

36 And he who had undertaken to accomplish the tribute to the Romans from the captivity of those in Ierosolyma proclaimed that the Judeans had a champion, and that for this reason the Judeans were invulnerable, because they followed the laws ordained by him.

Chapter 9

1 About that time Antiochos happened to have withdrawn in disorder from the regions around Persis.

2 For he had entered the city called Persepolis and attempted to plunder temples and hold the city; therefore, when the multitudes rushed to the aid of arms, they were routed, and it happened that Antiochos, routed by the inhabitants, made a disgraceful retreat.

3 While he was at Ekbatana, news of what had happened to Nikanor and those around Timotheos reached him.

4 Lifted up in anger, he thought to inflict upon the Jews also the malice of those who had put him to flight; therefore he ordered the charioteer to drive without stopping and complete the journey, the judgment from heaven already accompanying him; for he said thus arrogantly, “I will make Hierosolyma a mass grave of Jews when I arrive there.”

5 But the all-seeing Lord, the God of Israel, struck him with an incurable and invisible blow; and just as he finished the statement, an irremediable pain of the entrails and bitter torments within seized him,

6 very justly, since he had tormented the entrails of others with many strange calamities.

7 But he in no way ceased from his haughtiness, and was still filled with arrogance, breathing fire in his anger against the Jews and commanding that the journey be hastened. But it also happened that he fell from the chariot as it sped with a rushing sound, and, suffering a grievous fall, had all the limbs of his body twisted.

8 He who had just thought to command the waves of the sea because of his arrogance beyond human measure, and imagined he would weigh the heights of the mountains in a balance, having come to the ground, was carried along in a litter, displaying to all the manifest power of God,

9 so that worms swarmed up from the body of the impious man, and while he lived in anguish and pain his flesh fell away, and the whole camp was burdened with the putrefaction from his smell.

10 And no one could carry along him who a little earlier thought to touch the heavenly stars, because of the unbearable weight of the smell.

11 Then, therefore, shattered, he began to cease from his great arrogance and to come to recognition, being intensified in his pains at every moment by a divine scourge.

12 And unable even to endure his own smell, he said this: “It is just to submit to God and, being mortal, not to think oneself equal to God.”

13 But the polluted man prayed to the Master who would no longer have mercy on him, saying thus:

14 that he would declare free the holy city, which he was hastening to reach to level to the ground and build into a mass grave,

15 and would make all the Jews equal to Athenians, whom he had resolved not even to consider worthy of burial, but to cast out with their infants to beasts, to be eaten by birds;

16 and would adorn with most beautiful offerings the holy temple which he had previously plundered, and restore all the sacred vessels many times over, and supply from his own revenues the contributions required for the sacrifices;

17 and besides these things would also become a Jew and go through every inhabited place proclaiming the might of God.

18 But as the pains in no way ceased, for the just judgment of God had come upon him, despairing of his own situation, he wrote to the Jews the letter written below, having the character of a supplication, and containing the following:

19 “To the good Jews, the citizens, abundant greetings and health and prosperity, from King and General Antiochos.

20 If you and the children are well, and your affairs are according to your wishes; having my hope toward heaven,

21 I remembered your honor and goodwill affectionately. Returning from the regions of Persis and falling into an illness involving difficulty, I considered it necessary to think of the common security of all.

22 Not despairing of my own situation, but having much hope of escaping the illness,

23 and observing that my father also, at the times when he campaigned in the upper regions, designated his successor,

24 so that, if anything unexpected should happen or anything difficult be reported, those throughout the country, knowing to whom affairs have been left, might not be disturbed;

25 and besides these things considering that the neighboring rulers adjoining the kingdom watch the times and await what will happen, I have designated my son Antiochos king, whom I often entrusted and commended to most of you when going up to the upper satrapies; and I have written to him what is written below.

26 I therefore exhort you and ask that, remembering the benefits collectively and each individually, you maintain your existing goodwill toward me and my son;

27 for I am persuaded that he, following my policy with equity and humanity, will accommodate himself to you.”

28 So the murderer and blasphemer, having suffered the worst things, as he had treated others, ended his life in a foreign land in the mountains by a most pitiable fate.

29 Philippos, his companion from childhood, was conveying the body; he, fearing the son of Antiochos, also made his way to Ptolemaios Philometor in Egypt.

Chapter 10

1 Makkabaios and those with him, the Lord leading them, recovered the sanctuary and the city,

2 and tore down the altars constructed by the foreigners in the marketplace, and also sacred precincts,

3 and, purifying the temple, made another altar; and, heating stones and taking fire from them, offered sacrifices after a period of two years, and provided incense and lamps and the setting out of the loaves.

4 Having done these things, they fell upon their bellies and asked the Lord that they might no longer fall into such evils, but, if ever they should sin, might be disciplined by him with equity and not be handed over to blasphemous and barbarous nations.

5 On the day on which the temple had been profaned by foreigners, it happened that the purification of the temple took place on the same day, the twenty-fifth of the same month, which is Chaseleu.

6 And they celebrated eight days with gladness in the manner of booths, remembering how a little time before, at the feast of tents, they had been dwelling in the mountains and caves like beasts.

7 Therefore, bearing ivy-wreathed rods and beautiful branches, and also palms, they offered hymns to him who had prospered the purification of his own place.

8 They decreed by a common ordinance and vote that the whole nation of the Jews should celebrate these days yearly.

9 And thus were the circumstances of the death of Antiochos, who was called Epiphanes.

10 Now we will make known the affairs of Antiochos Eupator, who was the son of the impious man, abridging the evils attending the wars themselves.

11 For he, receiving the kingdom, appointed a certain Lysias over affairs, and chief general of Coele Syria and Phoinike.

12 For Ptolemaios, called Makron, preferring to maintain justice toward the Jews because of the injustice done to them, tried to conduct affairs with them peaceably;

13 therefore, being accused before Eupator by the Friends, and hearing himself called a traitor at every turn because he had abandoned Kypros, entrusted to him by Philometor, and withdrawn to Antiochos Epiphanes, and having failed to ennoble his authority as noble, he poisoned himself and departed from life.

14 Gorgias, becoming general of the regions, maintained mercenaries and at every turn fostered war against the Jews.

15 Together with him the Idoumaians also, holding strategically placed fortifications, harassed the Jews and, taking in those who had banished them from Hierosolyma, attempted to foster war.

16 Those around Makkabaios, making supplication and asking God to become their ally, rushed upon the fortifications of the Idoumaians,

17 and, attacking them vigorously, gained control of the places and repelled all those fighting upon the wall, and slaughtered those who fell into their hands; they killed no fewer than twenty thousand.

18 When no fewer than nine thousand fled together into two exceedingly strong towers, possessing everything needed for a siege,

19 Makkabaios, leaving Simon and Iosepos, and also Zakchaios and those with him, sufficient for their siege, himself departed to places requiring urgent attention.

20 But those around Simon, becoming greedy for money, were persuaded with silver by some of those in the towers; and, receiving seventy thousand drachmas, allowed some to slip away.

21 When what had happened was reported to Makkabaios, he gathered the leaders of the people and accused them of having sold their brothers for silver by releasing their enemies against them.

22 He therefore killed these men who had become traitors, and immediately took possession of the two towers.

23 Prospering in everything undertaken with arms in his hands, he destroyed more than twenty thousand in the two fortifications.

24 Timotheos, previously defeated by the Jews, gathered vast mercenary forces and assembled no few horses from Asia, and came intending to take Ioudaia as a conquest of the spear.

25 When he approached, those around Makkabaios, for supplication to God, sprinkled their heads with earth and girded their loins with sackcloth,

26 and, falling upon the step opposite the altar, asked him to become gracious to them, to be an enemy to their enemies and oppose those opposing them, as the law makes clear.

27 Leaving their prayer and taking up their arms, they advanced farther from the city; and, approaching the enemies, remained by themselves.

28 Just as the dawn spread, both sides attacked, the one having their refuge in the Lord as a guarantee of success and victory with valor, the other appointing anger as the leader of their contests.

29 When a fierce battle arose, five distinguished men from heaven upon horses with golden bridles appeared to the adversaries, and led the Jews,

30 who also took Makkabaios into their midst and, shielding him with their own full armor, kept him unwounded; and they hurled arrows and thunderbolts at the adversaries, who therefore, confused by blindness, were cut down, filled with turmoil.

31 Twenty thousand and five hundred were slaughtered, and six hundred cavalrymen.

32 Timotheos himself fled with others into the fortification called Gazara, an exceedingly strong fortress, where Chaireas was commander.

33 Those around Makkabaios gladly besieged the fortress for four days.

34 Those within, trusting in the strength of the place, blasphemed exceedingly and uttered unlawful words.

35 As the fifth day began to appear, twenty young men of those around Makkabaios, inflamed in anger because of the blasphemies, attacked the wall manfully and with beastlike fury cut down whoever they encountered;

36 others likewise climbed up during the diversion against those within and set the towers on fire, and, kindling fires, burned the blasphemers alive; others broke through the gates and, admitting the rest of the formation, took possession of the city.

37 And they slaughtered Timotheos, hidden in a certain pit, and his brother Chaireas and Apollophanes.

38 Having accomplished these things, with hymns and acknowledgments they blessed the Lord, who greatly benefited Israel and gave them the victory.

Chapter 11

1 After a very short little interval, Lysias, the king’s guardian and kinsman and the one over affairs, bearing what had happened very heavily,

2 gathered about eighty thousand and all the cavalry, and came against the Jews, calculating that he would make the city a dwelling place for Greeks,

3 and the sanctuary subject to a levy of silver, like the other sacred precincts of the nations, and would make the high priesthood purchasable yearly,

4 in no way reckoning with the might of God, but elated by the tens of thousands of infantry and the thousands of cavalry and the eighty elephants.

5 Entering Ioudaia and approaching Baithsoura, which was a strong place and about five stadia distant from Hierosolyma, he pressed it hard.

6 When those around Makkabaios learned that he was besieging the fortifications, with lamentations and tears they supplicated the Lord together with the multitudes to send a good angel for the salvation of Israel.

7 Makkabaios himself first took up arms and exhorted the others to risk themselves together with him to aid their brothers; and they set out together eagerly.

8 While they were there near Hierosolyma, a horseman in white clothing appeared, leading them, brandishing golden armor.

9 Together they all blessed the merciful God and were strengthened in their souls, being ready to pierce not only men, but the wildest beasts and walls of iron.

10 They advanced in battle array, having their ally from heaven, the Lord having shown them mercy.

11 Charging like lions into the enemies, they laid low eleven thousand of them, and sixteen hundred cavalrymen; and compelled them all to flee.

12 Most of them escaped wounded and naked; and Lysias himself also escaped, fleeing disgracefully.

13 Being no fool, he considered within himself the loss that had befallen him, and realized that the Hebrews were invincible when the powerful God fought alongside them,

14 and sent to them and persuaded them to settle on all just terms, and that he would also persuade the king, compelling him to become their friend.

15 Makkabaios consented to all that Lysias requested, taking thought for what was advantageous; for all that Makkabaios submitted to Lysias in writing concerning the Jews, the king granted.

16 For the letters written to the Jews by Lysias contained the following: “Lysias to the multitude of the Jews, greetings.

17 Ioannes and Abessalom, sent by you, submitted the communication written below and made requests concerning the matters indicated by it.

18 Whatever therefore needed to be brought before the king also, I made clear; and what was admissible, he granted.

19 If therefore you maintain your goodwill toward affairs, I will try in the future also to be instrumental in good things.

20 Concerning these things and the particulars, I have instructed both these men and those from me to speak with you.

21 Farewell. Year one hundred and forty-eight, the twenty-fourth of Dios Korinthios.”

22 The king’s letter contained the following: “King Antiochos to his brother Lysias, greetings.

23 Our father having departed to the gods, we wish those of the kingdom to be undisturbed in attending to their own affairs,

24 and have heard that the Jews do not approve of our father’s change to Greek ways, but prefer their own manner of life and ask that their lawful customs be permitted them;

25 therefore, choosing that this nation also be free from disturbance, we judge that the sanctuary should be restored to them and that they should conduct their life according to the customs of their ancestors.

26 You will therefore do well to send to them and give pledges, so that, knowing our policy, they may be of good cheer and gladly occupy themselves with the management of their own affairs.”

27 The king’s letter to the nation was as follows: “King Antiochos to the senate of the Jews and the other Jews, greetings.

28 If you are well, it would be as we wish; we ourselves also are in health.

29 Menelaos informed us that you wish to come down and attend to your own affairs.

30 Therefore, for those coming down by the thirtieth of Xanthikos there will be a pledge with permission

31 for the Jews to use their own provisions and laws, as formerly also, and none of them will be harassed in any manner concerning the things done in ignorance.

32 I have also sent Menelaos to encourage you.

33 Farewell. Year one hundred and forty-eight, the fifteenth of Xanthikos.”

34 The Romans also sent them a letter containing the following: “Kointos Memmios, Titos Manios, ambassadors of the Romans, to the people of the Jews, greetings.

35 Concerning what Lysias, the king’s kinsman, granted you, we too approve.

36 But concerning what he judged should be brought before the king, consider these matters and send someone immediately, so that we may set them forth as is appropriate for you; for we are proceeding toward Antiocheia.

37 Therefore hasten and send some men, so that we too may know what opinion you hold.

38 Be in health. Year one hundred and forty-eight, the fifteenth of Xanthikos.”

Chapter 12

1 When these agreements had been made, Lysias went away to the king, and the Jews occupied themselves with agriculture.

2 But of the local generals, Timotheos and Apollonios son of Gennaios, and also Hieronymos and Demophon, and besides these Nikanor the governor of Kypros, did not allow them to remain settled and live quietly.

3 The Ioppites committed this great impious deed: they invited the Jews dwelling with them to embark with their wives and children in the boats they had provided, as though no hostility toward them existed,

4 and according to the common vote of the city; and when they accepted, as wishing to live in peace and having no suspicion, they took them out and drowned them, no fewer than two hundred.

5 Ioudas, learning of the cruelty done to his fellow countrymen, gave orders to the men around him

6 and, invoking God, the just judge, came against the murderers of his brothers, and burned the harbor by night and set the boats ablaze, and pierced those who had fled together there.

7 But when the place was shut up, he withdrew, intending to come again and uproot the whole community of the Ioppites.

8 Learning also that those in Iamneia wished to deal in the same manner with the Jews dwelling among them,

9 he attacked the Iamnites by night and set the harbor on fire together with the fleet, so that the rays of the light were visible in Hierosolyma, two hundred and forty stadia away.

10 When they had withdrawn nine stadia from there, while making their journey against Timotheos, Arabs, no fewer than five thousand, and five hundred cavalrymen attacked him.

11 A fierce battle arose, and those around Ioudas prospered through the help from God; the nomads, defeated, asked Ioudas to give them pledges, promising both to give livestock and to benefit them in other matters.

12 Ioudas, considering that they were truly useful in many things, agreed to keep peace with them; and, receiving pledges, they departed to their tents.

13 He also attacked a certain city, strong with earthworks and enclosed by walls and inhabited by a mixture of nations, whose name was Kaspin.

14 Those within, trusting in the strength of the walls and the stores of food, treated those around Ioudas very rudely, reviling and further blaspheming and saying things that were not lawful.

15 Those around Ioudas, invoking the great Sovereign of the world, who without rams and mechanical engines had hurled down Iericho in the times of Iesous, hurled themselves fiercely against the wall.

16 Taking possession of the city by the will of God, they wrought unspeakable slaughter, so that the adjoining lake, two stadia in breadth, appeared flooded and filled with blood.

17 Withdrawing from there, they completed seven hundred and fifty stadia to Charax, to the Jews called Toubianoi.

18 They did not find Timotheos in the regions, as he had then withdrawn from the regions without accomplishing anything, but had left a very strong garrison in a certain place.

19 Dositheos and Sosipatros, commanders of those around Makkabaios, marched out and destroyed those left by Timotheos in the fortification, more than ten thousand men.

20 Makkabaios, arranging the army around him by companies, appointed them over the companies and rushed against Timotheos, who had around him one hundred and twenty thousand infantry and twenty-five hundred cavalrymen.

21 Learning of the approach of Ioudas, Timotheos sent ahead the women and children and the other baggage into the place called Karnion; for the place was difficult to besiege and difficult to approach because of the narrowness of all the approaches.

22 When the first company of Ioudas appeared, and dread came upon the enemies and fear from the manifestation of him who oversees all things came upon them, they rushed into flight, each being carried in a different direction, so that they were often injured by their own men and impaled on the points of their swords.

23 Ioudas pursued more vigorously, piercing the offenders, and destroyed about thirty thousand men.

24 Timotheos himself, falling into the hands of those around Dositheos and Sosipatros, requested with much deception that they release him safe, because he held the parents of many and the brothers of some, and it would happen that these would be disregarded.

25 When he had confirmed through many assurances the agreement to restore these unharmed, they released him for the sake of the safety of their brothers.

26 Going out against Karnion and the Atergateion, he slaughtered twenty-five thousand persons.

27 After their rout and destruction he also marched against Ephron, a strong city, in which Lysias and multitudes of every tribe dwelt; strong young men stationed before the walls fought back vigorously, and there were many stores of engines and missiles there.

28 Invoking the Sovereign who powerfully crushes the strength of enemies, they brought the city under their hand and laid low about twenty-five thousand of those within.

29 Departing from there, they set out against the city of the Scythians, six hundred stadia distant from Hierosolyma.

30 The Jews settled there testified to the goodwill which the Scythopolitans had toward them, and their gentle treatment in the times of misfortune,

31 and, giving thanks and further exhorting them to be well-disposed toward their people in the future also, they arrived in Hierosolyma, the feast of weeks being near.

32 After the feast called Pentecost, they set out against Gorgias, the general of Idoumaia.

33 He came out with three thousand infantry and four hundred cavalrymen.

34 When they engaged in battle, it happened that a few of the Jews fell.

35 A certain Dositheos of the men of Bakenor, a strong mounted man, held onto Gorgias and, grasping his cloak, dragged him vigorously, wishing to take the accursed man alive; but when one of the Thracian cavalrymen charged him and struck down his shoulder, Gorgias escaped to Marisa.

36 Those around Esdris having fought for a long time and being exhausted, Ioudas invoked the Lord to appear as an ally and leader of the war;

37 beginning the shout with hymns in the ancestral language, and charging unexpectedly against those around Gorgias, he brought about their rout.

38 Ioudas, taking up the army, came to the city of Odollam; and as the seventh day approached, they purified themselves according to custom and passed the sabbath there.

39 On the following day, when it had become necessary, those around Ioudas came to recover the bodies of those who had fallen and restore them with their relatives to the ancestral tombs.

40 Under the tunics of each of the dead they found sacred objects of the idols from Iamneia, from which the law forbids the Jews; and it became clear to all that these men had fallen for this reason.

41 Therefore all, blessing the deeds of the Lord, the just judge who makes hidden things manifest,

42 turned to supplication, asking that the sin committed be completely blotted out. The noble Ioudas exhorted the multitude to keep themselves without sin, having seen before their eyes what had happened because of the sin of those who had fallen.

43 Making a collection man by man amounting to two thousand silver drachmas, he sent it to Hierosolyma to offer a sacrifice for sin, acting very well and nobly, taking thought concerning resurrection;

44 for if he were not expecting those who had fallen to rise, it would be superfluous and foolish to pray for the dead;

45 or else looking to a most beautiful reward laid up for those who fall asleep in piety, the thought was holy and pious; therefore he made expiation concerning the dead, that they might be released from sin.

Chapter 13

1 In the one hundred and forty-ninth year, news reached those around Ioudas that Antiochos Eupator was coming with multitudes against Ioudaia,

2 and with him Lysias, the guardian and the one over affairs, each having a Greek force of one hundred and ten thousand infantry and five thousand three hundred cavalrymen and twenty-two elephants, and three hundred scythed chariots.

3 Menelaos also joined them and encouraged Antiochos with much dissimulation, not for the salvation of his homeland, but imagining that he would be established in office.

4 But the King of kings roused the anger of Antiochos against the offender; and when Lysias pointed out that this man was responsible for all the evils, he commanded them to take him to Beroia and put him to death, as is the custom in the place.

5 In the place there is a tower of fifty cubits, full of ashes, and it had a circular contrivance, precipitous on every side into the ashes.

6 There they all push to destruction anyone guilty of temple plundering or one who has committed an excess of certain other evils.

7 By such a fate it happened that the lawless Menelaos died, obtaining not even earth;

8 very justly; for since he had committed many sins concerning the altar, whose fire and ashes were pure, he received death in ashes.

9 The king, made barbarous in his intentions, was coming to show the Jews the worst things that had happened under his father.

10 Ioudas, learning these things, commanded the multitude to invoke the Lord day and night, if ever at any other time, now also to aid those about to be deprived of law and homeland and holy sanctuary,

11 and not to allow the people who had just briefly revived to become subject to the ill-speaking nations.

12 When all had done the same together and petitioned the merciful Lord with weeping and fasts and prostration for three days without ceasing, Ioudas encouraged them and commanded them to assemble.

13 Meeting privately with the elders, he resolved that before the king’s army invaded Ioudaia and gained control of the city, they should go out and decide matters with the help of God.

14 Entrusting the direction to the Creator of the world, he exhorted those with him to contend nobly to death for laws, sanctuary, city, homeland, citizenship; and he made his camp around Modein.

15 Giving those around him the watchword “God’s victory,” with chosen excellent young men he attacked by night the camp at the royal quarters and killed about two thousand men, and pierced the foremost of the elephants together with the one in its housing,

16 and finally they filled the camp with dread and turmoil and withdrew successfully;

17 this had happened as day was already beginning to appear, because of the Lord’s protection aiding him.

18 The king, having received a taste of the Jews’ boldness, tried the places by stratagems.

19 He advanced against Baithsoura, a strong fortress of the Jews, was routed, encountered resistance, was defeated;

20 and Ioudas sent the necessities in to those within.

21 Rodokos of the Jewish ranks reported the secrets to the enemies; he was sought out and seized and confined.

22 The king spoke a second time to those in Baithsoura, gave a pledge, received one, went away, attacked those around Ioudas, was defeated,

23 learned that Philippos, left over affairs in Antiocheia, had become desperate, was disturbed, appealed to the Jews, submitted and swore to all just terms, made a settlement and offered a sacrifice, honored the temple and treated the place humanely;

24 and he received Makkabaios, left Hegemonides as general from Ptolemais as far as the Gerrhenoi.

25 He came to Ptolemais; the Ptolemaians were displeased with the agreements, for they were indignant over them and wished to annul the stipulations.

26 Lysias went up to the platform, defended the matter as well as possible, persuaded them, calmed them, made them well-disposed, departed to Antiocheia. Thus proceeded the matters of the king’s advance and departure.

Chapter 14

1 After a period of three years, news reached those around Ioudas that Demetrios son of Seleukos, sailing in through the harbor at Tripolis with a strong multitude and a fleet,

2 had gained control of the country, having killed Antiochos and his guardian Lysias.

3 A certain Alkimos, formerly high priest, but voluntarily defiled in the times of separation, realizing that in no manner was there safety for him or any longer access to the holy altar,

4 came to King Demetrios about the one hundred and fifty-first year, bringing him a golden crown and a palm, and besides these some of the customary branches of the sanctuary, and kept quiet that day.

5 Taking an opportunity as an accomplice of his own folly, when summoned to council by Demetrios and asked in what disposition and intention the Jews stood, he said in response:

6 “Those of the Jews called Asidaioi, whom Ioudas Makkabaios leads, foster war and raise sedition, not allowing the kingdom to obtain stability.

7 Therefore, having laid aside my ancestral glory [I mean the high priesthood], I have now come here,

8 first, genuinely taking thought for the matters belonging to the king, and second, also considering my own fellow citizens; for through the recklessness of the aforementioned men our whole people suffers no small misfortune.

9 Having learned each of these things, you, O king, take thought both for the country and for our beleaguered people, according to the gracious humanity you have toward all.

10 For as long as Ioudas survives, it is impossible for affairs to obtain peace.”

11 When such things were spoken by him, the other Friends, hostile toward Ioudas, quickly inflamed Demetrios further.

12 Immediately choosing Nikanor, formerly commander of the elephants, and appointing him general of Ioudaia, he sent him out,

13 giving orders to kill Ioudas himself, scatter those with him, and establish Alkimos as high priest of the greatest sanctuary.

14 The nations throughout Ioudaia who had put Ioudas to flight joined Nikanor in herds, thinking that the misfortunes and calamities of the Jews would be their own successes.

15 Hearing of Nikanor’s advance and the attack of the nations, they sprinkled themselves with earth and supplicated him who had established his own people forever and always helps his own portion by manifestation.

16 At the leader’s command, immediately departing from there, he meets them at the village of Dessaou.

17 Simon, the brother of Ioudas, had engaged Nikanor, but had stumbled slowly because of the sudden speechlessness of the opponents;

18 nevertheless Nikanor, hearing of the valor which those around Ioudas possessed and their courage in contests for their homeland, was wary of deciding the matter through bloodshed.

19 Therefore he sent Posidonios and Theodotos and Mattathias to give and receive pledges.

20 When considerable examination of these matters had taken place, and the leader had communicated with the multitudes, and a unanimous opinion appeared, they agreed to the terms.

21 They appointed a day on which they would meet privately in the same place; and a two-seated chariot came forward from each, and they set out seats.

22 Ioudas stationed armed men ready in strategically placed positions, lest wickedness suddenly arise from the enemies; they held the appropriate conference.

23 Nikanor stayed in Hierosolyma and did nothing improper, and dismissed the multitudes gathered in herds.

24 He kept Ioudas continually in his presence; he was attached to the man in soul.

25 He encouraged him to marry and beget children; he married, settled down, shared in life.

26 But Alkimos, perceiving their goodwill toward each other and taking the agreements that had been made, came to Demetrios and said that Nikanor was thinking contrary to affairs; for he had designated Ioudas, the plotter against the kingdom, as his own successor.

27 The king, becoming enraged and provoked by the slanders of the utterly wicked man, wrote to Nikanor, declaring that he was displeased with the agreements, and commanding him to send Makkabaios bound to Antiocheia quickly.

28 When these things reached Nikanor, he was disturbed and distressed that he would annul the stipulations when the man had done no wrong.

29 But since it was not possible to act against the king, he watched for a favorable opportunity to accomplish this by stratagem.

30 Makkabaios, seeing that Nikanor was conducting his dealings with him more harshly and had made their customary meetings more rude, and understanding that the harshness did not come from the best intention, gathered no few of those around him and hid from Nikanor.

31 The other, recognizing that he had been skillfully outmaneuvered by the man, came to the greatest and holy sanctuary while the priests were offering the due sacrifices and commanded them to hand over the man.

32 When they declared with oaths that they did not know where the man sought was,

33 he stretched his right hand toward the temple and swore these things: “Unless you hand Ioudas over to me bound, I will make this enclosure of God into a plain and dig down the altar and raise a conspicuous sanctuary here to Dionysos.”

34 Having said these things, he went away; the priests, stretching their hands toward heaven, invoked him who continually champions our nation, saying these things:

35 “You, Lord of all, being in need of nothing, were pleased that a temple for your dwelling should come to be among us;

36 and now, holy Lord of all sanctification, preserve forever undefiled this house recently purified.”

37 A certain Razis, one of the elders from Hierosolyma, was denounced to Nikanor, a man who loved his fellow citizens and was exceedingly well spoken of, and for his goodwill was called father of the Jews.

38 For in the former times of separation he had been brought to judgment for Judaism, and had risked both body and soul for Judaism with all earnestness.

39 Nikanor, wishing to make evident the hostility he had toward the Jews, sent more than five hundred soldiers to arrest him;

40 for he thought that by arresting that man he would work calamity upon them.

41 When the multitudes were about to capture the tower and were forcing the courtyard door and commanding that fire be brought and the doors set alight, being surrounded, he turned his sword against himself,

42 wishing to die nobly rather than become subject to the offenders and be outraged unworthily of his own nobility.

43 But not striking true with the blow because of the haste of the contest, and the multitudes invading within the doorways, he ran nobly up onto the wall and manfully hurled himself down into the multitudes.

44 They quickly stepped back, leaving a space, and he landed in the middle of the empty space.

45 Still breathing and inflamed in spirit, he rose, his blood flowing in streams and his wounds being grievous, ran through the multitudes and stood upon a precipitous rock,

46 already becoming wholly drained of blood, pulled out his entrails and took them in both hands and hurled them at the multitudes, and, invoking the Master of life and spirit to restore these to him again, departed in this manner.

Chapter 15

1 Nikanor, learning that those around Ioudas were in the regions of Samareia, resolved to attack them with complete security on the day of rest.

2 When the Jews accompanying him under compulsion said, “By no means destroy so savagely and barbarously, but allot glory to the day honored with holiness by him who oversees all things,”

3 the thrice-offending man asked whether there was a Sovereign in heaven who had ordered the observance of the sabbath day;

4 when they declared, “There is the living Lord himself, Sovereign in heaven, who commanded the observance of the seventh day,”

5 the other says, “I too am a sovereign upon earth, who commands the taking up of arms and the performance of the king’s requirements.” Nevertheless he did not succeed in accomplishing his cruel intention.

6 Nikanor, lifting his neck with all arrogance, had resolved to set up a common trophy over those around Ioudas.

7 But Makkabaios was continually confident, with all hope, that he would obtain help from the Lord,

8 and encouraged those with him not to fear the advance of the nations, but, keeping in mind the helps from heaven that had previously come to them, now also to expect the victory that would be theirs from the Almighty.

9 Comforting them from the law and the prophets, and further reminding them of the contests they had accomplished, he made them more eager.

10 Rousing them in spirit, he gave orders, at the same time pointing out the faithlessness of the nations and their violation of oaths.

11 Arming each of them not so much with the security of shields and spears as with the encouragement in good words, and further relating a trustworthy dream, something like a waking vision, he gladdened them all.

12 Its vision was as follows: Onias, who had been high priest, a fine and good man, modest in his encounters, gentle in manner and uttering speech fittingly, and from childhood having practiced all things belonging to virtue, stretched out his hands and prayed for the whole body of the Jews.

13 Then in this manner a man appeared, distinguished by gray hair and glory, and the majesty around him was wondrous and most magnificent.

14 Onias answered and said, “This is the lover of the brothers, who prays much for the people and the holy city, Ieremias, the prophet of God.”

15 Ieremias stretched out his right hand and handed Ioudas a golden sword, and, giving it, addressed him thus:

16 “Take the holy sword, a gift from God, through which you will shatter the adversaries.”

17 Encouraged by the words of Ioudas, very fine and able to impel to valor and make the souls of the young manly, they resolved not to campaign, but to charge nobly and, engaging with all manliness, decide matters, because the city and the holy things and the sanctuary were in danger;

18 for concern for wives and children, and also brothers and relatives, occupied a lesser place for them, but the fear for the consecrated temple was greatest and first.

19 Those confined in the city also had no incidental anxiety, being disturbed about the attack in the open country.

20 When all were already awaiting the coming decision, and the enemies had already approached, and the army had been drawn out and the beasts stationed at a suitable position and the cavalry arranged on the flank,

21 Makkabaios, seeing the presence of the multitudes and the varied equipment of arms and the savagery of the beasts, raised his hands toward heaven and invoked the wonder-working Lord, knowing that it is not through arms, but as it may be judged by him, that he secures victory for the worthy.

22 Invoking him, he spoke in this manner: “You, Master, sent your angel in the time of Ezekias, king of Ioudaia, and he killed about one hundred and eighty-five thousand from the camp of Sennacherim;

23 and now, Sovereign of the heavens, send a good angel before us for dread and trembling;

24 by the greatness of your arm may those coming with blasphemy against your holy people be struck with terror.” And he ended with these words.

25 Those around Nikanor advanced with trumpets and paeans.

26 Those around Ioudas engaged the enemies with invocation and prayers.

27 Contending with their hands and praying to God with their hearts, they laid low no fewer than thirty-five thousand, greatly gladdened by the manifestation of God.

28 Leaving the engagement and withdrawing with joy, they recognized that Nikanor had fallen with his full armor.

29 A shout and commotion arose, and they blessed the Sovereign in the ancestral language.

30 He who in every respect was the foremost champion in body and soul for the citizens, who had preserved his lifelong goodwill toward his fellow countrymen, commanded them to cut off Nikanor’s head and his hand with the shoulder and carry them to Hierosolyma.

31 Arriving there and calling together his fellow countrymen and stationing the priests before the altar, he sent for those from the citadel.

32 Showing the head of the polluted Nikanor and the hand of the ill-speaking man, which he had stretched out against the holy house of the Almighty and boasted greatly,

33 and cutting out the tongue of the impious Nikanor, he said he would give it piece by piece to the birds, and hang up the recompense of his folly opposite the temple.

34 They all blessed toward heaven the manifest Lord, saying, “Blessed is he who preserved his own place undefiled.”

35 He hung Nikanor’s head from the citadel, a sign visible to all and manifest of the Lord’s help.

36 They all decreed by a common vote by no means to leave this day unmarked, but to keep conspicuous the thirteenth of the twelfth month — called Adar in the Syrian language — one day before the day of Mardochaios.

37 The affairs concerning Nikanor having proceeded thus, and the city having been held by the Hebrews from those times, I too will cease the account here.

38 If well and aptly in composition, this I myself wished; but if cheaply and moderately, this was attainable for me.

39 For just as drinking wine alone, and likewise water alone again, is harmful, but wine mixed with water is sweet and produces delightful pleasure, so also the construction of the account delights the ears of those who encounter the composition. Here will be the end.

3 Maccabees

Chapter 1

1 Philopator, learning from those who had returned that the regions under his control had been taken away by Antiochos, gave orders to all the infantry and cavalry forces and, taking along his sister Arsinoe, set out as far as the regions around Raphia, where those around Antiochos had encamped.

2 A certain Theodotos, intending to fulfill the plot, took the best of the Ptolemaic arms previously assigned to him and made his way by night to Ptolemaios’s tent, intending to kill him single-handedly and thereby end the war.

3 But Dositheos, called the son of Drimylos, a Jew by birth, but later having changed his lawful customs and become alienated from the ancestral ordinances, had taken him away and laid down an obscure man in the tent, who happened to receive the punishment intended for him.

4 When a fierce battle arose and affairs were going considerably better for Antiochos, Arsinoe went through the forces and, with compassion and tears and her locks loosened, exhorted them to aid themselves and their children and wives boldly, promising to give each two minas of gold if they conquered.

5 And thus it happened that the opponents were destroyed in hand-to-hand fighting, and many were also captured as prisoners of the spear.

6 Having overcome the plot, he decided to visit and encourage the nearby cities.

7 Having done this and allotted gifts to the sacred precincts, he made his subjects confident.

8 When the Jews sent to him men from the senate and the elders to greet him and bring gifts of hospitality and congratulate him on what had happened, it happened that he became more eager to visit them as quickly as possible.

9 Making his way to Hierosolyma and sacrificing to the greatest God and giving thanks and doing something further for the place, and indeed coming to the place and being struck by its dignity and beauty,

10 and also admiring the good order of the sanctuary, he conceived the intention of entering the temple.

11 When they said that this ought not to happen, because not even those of the nation were permitted to enter, nor all the priests, but only the high priest who presided over all, and he once a year, he was in no way persuaded.

12 When the law was read aloud, he did not desist even then, asserting that he ought to enter, saying, “Even if they are deprived of this honor, I ought not to be.”

13 And he inquired for what reason none of those present had prevented him when he entered every sacred precinct.

14 And someone heedlessly said that this very thing was wrongly made much of as a marvel.

15 “But if this happened for some reason,” he says, “will I not certainly enter, whether they wish it or not?”

16 When the priests fell down in all their vestments and begged the greatest God to aid them in their present circumstances and turn aside the impulse of the one making the wicked attack, and filled the sanctuary with crying and tears,

17 those remaining throughout the city, disturbed, rushed out, considering what was happening uncertain.

18 The virgins confined in chambers rushed out with their mothers and, sprinkling their hair, gave it over to dust, and filled the broad streets with lamentation and groans.

19 Those also who had just been arrayed, abandoning the bridal chambers prepared for the meeting and the appropriate modesty, took to a disorderly course through the city.

20 The mothers and nurses attending the newborn children abandoned them here and there, some in houses and some in the streets, and gathered without turning back into the supremely exalted sanctuary.

21 Varied was the supplication of those gathered into it concerning the things impiously undertaken by him.

22 Together with these, those who had become bold on behalf of the citizens could not endure his pressing on completely and intending to fulfill his purpose,

23 and, crying out to rush to arms and die boldly for the ancestral law, caused considerable agitation in the place; but, barely turned aside by the aged men and the elders, they came to the same position of supplication.

24 The multitude continued in these things as before, making supplication.

25 The elders around the king tried in many ways to turn his haughty mind away from the intended plot.

26 But, growing bold and dismissing everything, he was already making his approach, thinking to bring the aforementioned matter to completion.

27 Those around him also, seeing these things, turned to invoking with our people him who possesses all might, to aid those present, not overlooking the lawless and arrogant deed.

28 From the exceedingly dense and anguished crying of the multitudes gathered together there arose an indescribable clamor;

29 for it seemed that not only the people, but also the walls and the whole ground resounded, since all were then choosing death in exchange for the profanation of the place.

Chapter 2

1 The high priest Simon, bending his knees opposite the temple and stretching out his hands, therefore made this supplication in an orderly manner:

2 “Lord, Lord, King of the heavens and Master of all creation, holy among holy ones, sole Ruler, Almighty, attend to us, oppressed by an impious and profane man puffed up with audacity and strength.

3 For you who created all things and rule over everything are a just Sovereign, and judge those who act with insolence and haughtiness.

4 You destroyed those who formerly committed injustice, among whom were also giants trusting in strength and audacity, bringing immeasurable water upon them.

5 You burned with fire and sulfur the Sodomites who practiced arrogance and became conspicuous for their wickedness, making them an example for those coming afterward.

6 You, testing with many and varied punishments the audacious Pharao who had enslaved your holy people Israel, made known your power, whereby you made known your great might;

7 and when he pursued with chariots and a multitude of crowds, you overwhelmed him in the depth of the sea, but brought safely through those who trusted in you, who rule over all creation,

8 who also, seeing the works of your hand, praised you, the Almighty.

9 You, O King, creating the boundless and immeasurable earth, chose this city and sanctified this place for your name, you who need none of all things, and glorified it in a magnificent manifestation, establishing it for the glory of your great and honored name.

10 Loving the house of Israel, you promised that if we should turn away and distress overtake us, and we should come into this place and supplicate, you would hear our supplication.

11 And indeed you are faithful and true.

12 Since, when our fathers were often afflicted, you aided them in their humiliation and rescued them from great evils,

13 behold now, holy King, because of our many and great sins we are oppressed and have been subjected to our enemies and are enfeebled in weaknesses.

14 In our downfall this audacious and profane man undertakes to outrage the holy place designated upon earth for the name of your glory.

15 For your dwelling place is the heaven of heaven, inaccessible to men.

16 But since, being pleased with your glory among your people Israel, you sanctified this place,

17 do not punish us through their uncleanness or chastise us through profanation, lest the lawless boast in their anger or exult in the arrogance of their tongue, saying,

18 ‘We trampled the house of sanctification, as the houses of abominations are trampled.’

19 Blot out our sins and scatter our errors and manifest your mercy at this hour.

20 Let your compassions quickly come beforehand to meet us, and put praises in the mouth of those fallen and crushed in soul, making peace for us.”

21 Then God, the Overseer of all and Forefather, holy among holy ones, hearing the lawful supplication, scourged him who was greatly lifted up in insolence and audacity,

22 shaking him to and fro like a reed in the wind, so that he lay helpless upon the ground, also paralyzed in his limbs, unable even to speak, struck all around by a just judgment.

23 Therefore the Friends and bodyguards, seeing the sharp chastisement that had overtaken him and fearing that he might even cease to live, quickly dragged him out, struck with overwhelming fear.

24 Later, after some time, recovering himself, he in no way came to repentance after being rebuked, but uttered bitter threats and withdrew.

25 Making his way into Egypt and increasing his wickedness through the previously mentioned drinking companions and associates, separated from all justice,

26 he was not satisfied merely with countless acts of licentiousness, but advanced to such audacity that ill-speaking arose in the regions, and many of the Friends, looking intently at the king’s purpose, themselves also followed his will.

27 He proposed to spread public reproach against the nation; setting up a pillar on the tower at the palace, he carved an inscription:

28 that none of those who did not sacrifice should enter their sanctuaries, and that all the Jews should be brought to registration and the condition of slaves, and that those objecting should be taken by force and removed from life,

29 and those registered should also be marked on the body by fire with an ivy leaf, the emblem of Dionysos, and enrolled under the previously stipulated authority.

30 But so that he might not appear hateful to all, he added underneath: “If any of them choose to associate with those initiated in the rites, these shall be equal citizens with the Alexandrians.”

31 Some therefore, superficially loathing the foundations of the city’s piety, readily gave themselves over, as though they would share some great glory from their coming association with the king.

32 But most held firm with noble soul and did not depart from piety, and, exchanging their possessions for their life, fearlessly tried to rescue themselves from the registrations;

33 and they remained hopeful of obtaining help, and abhorred those departing from them and judged them as enemies of the nation, and deprived them of common association and beneficial services.

Chapter 3

1 Learning these things, the impious man became so enraged that he was not only furious with those in Alexandreia, but opposed those in the country more grievously, and commanded that they hasten to gather all into the same place and remove them from life by the worst fate.

2 While these things were being arranged, a hostile report resounded against the people through men united in purpose for evildoing, an occasion being given for their disposition, as though the Jews were preventing them from their lawful customs.

3 But the Jews had been maintaining unwavering goodwill and faithfulness toward the kings,

4 and, revering God and conducting their life by his law, kept separate in matters of food, for which reason they appeared hateful to some.

5 But, adorning their association by the good practice of just deeds, they had become well esteemed by all men.

6 The foreigners therefore in no way took account of the good conduct of the people, talked of among all,

7 but kept talking of the difference concerning acts of worship and foods, asserting that these men were allied by treaty neither with the king nor with the forces, but were hostile and greatly opposed affairs; and they attached no ordinary reproach to them.

8 The Greeks throughout the city, having suffered no wrong, seeing unexpected disturbance concerning these men and heedless gatherings taking place, had no strength to help, for the disposition was tyrannical, but encouraged them and were distressed and supposed that these things would change;

9 for so great a body, having done nothing wrong, would not be overlooked in this manner.

10 Already some neighbors and friends and business associates, drawing some aside secretly, gave assurances that they would stand alongside them and bring every earnest effort to their assistance.

11 He therefore, elated by his present success and not perceiving the might of the greatest God, but supposing that he would continually persist in the same purpose, wrote this letter against them:

12 “King Ptolemaios Philopator to the generals and soldiers throughout Egypt and in each place, greetings and health;

13 I myself also am well, and our affairs are well.

14 Our campaign into Asia, of which you yourselves also know, having been brought duly to completion through the unfailing alliance of the gods,

15 we thought to nurture the nations inhabiting Coele Syria and Phoinike, not by force of the spear, but by equity and much humanity, and gladly to benefit them.

16 Allotting very great revenues to the sanctuaries in each city, we proceeded also to go up to Hierosolyma and honor the sanctuary of the offenders who never cease from folly.

17 They welcomed our presence in word, but in deed insincerely, and when we were eager to enter their temple and honor it with distinguished and most beautiful offerings,

18 carried away by ancient conceits, they excluded us from entry, falling short of our strength because of the humanity we have toward all men.

19 Making their hostility toward us evident, as though they alone among the nations lift their necks against kings and their own benefactors, they are unwilling to offer anything genuine.

20 But we, bearing with their folly and making our way with victory into Egypt, treated all nations humanely, doing as was fitting,

21 and among these made our freedom from resentment toward their fellow tribesmen known to all; and, because of their alliance and the countless affairs entrusted to them with simplicity from the beginning, daring to alter matters, we wished also to deem them worthy of Alexandrian citizenship and make them participants in the perpetual sacred rites.

22 But they, taking the contrary view and rejecting what is good through their innate ill nature, and continually inclining toward what is base,

23 not only turned away from the priceless citizenship, but also abhor in word and silence the few among them genuinely disposed toward us, at every turn suspecting that we will quickly overthrow their affairs, with their most inglorious manner of life.

24 Therefore, well persuaded by proofs that these men are ill-disposed toward us in every manner, and taking thought lest, if sudden disturbance should arise for us afterward, we have these impious men behind us as traitors and barbarous enemies,

25 we have commanded that, as soon as this letter arrives, immediately those dwelling there, with wives and children, be sent to us with insults and maltreatment, confined on every side in iron bonds, for an irremediable and inglorious slaughter fitting for enemies.

26 For with these punished together, we have determined that for the remaining time our affairs will be established completely in stability and the best condition.

27 Whoever shelters any of the Jews, from an aged man to an infant and even those at the breast, will be beaten to death with the most disgraceful tortures, together with his whole household.

28 Let whoever wishes inform, on condition that he shall receive the property of the one falling under the punishment and two thousand silver drachmas from the royal treasury, and shall be crowned with freedom.

29 Every place where a Jew is found sheltered at all shall become inaccessible and burned with fire, and shall appear wholly useless to every mortal creature for all time.”

30 And the form of the letter had been written thus.

Chapter 4

1 Everywhere this ordinance arrived, a public banquet arose among the nations with shouts and joy, as the hatred long hardened in their minds now appeared openly.

2 But for the Jews there was unceasing grief and a wholly lamentable cry with tears, their hearts everywhere inflamed with groans as they lamented the unexpected destruction suddenly decreed against them.

3 What district or city or inhabited place at all, or what streets, were not filled with beating of breasts and lamentations for them?

4 For they were sent away with such bitterness of a merciless soul by the generals in each city, all with one accord, that even some of their enemies, in view of the extraordinary punishments, placing common compassion before their eyes and considering the uncertain end of life, wept at their most miserable deportation.

5 For a multitude of aged men, covered with gray hair, was led along, their stooping slowness of feet from old age being driven to a swift march by the impulse of violent overthrow, without any respect.

6 The young women who had just entered the bridal chamber for partnership of life, receiving lamentations instead of delight and mingling their perfume-soaked hair with dust, and being led unveiled, began a lament together instead of wedding songs, as though torn apart by maltreatment from foreign nations;

7 and bound in public, they were dragged by force until their embarkation into the ship.

8 Their spouses also, their necks entangled in nooses instead of wreaths, in the prime of youthful age, passed the remaining days of their wedding in lamentations instead of feasting and youthful ease, already seeing Hades lying at their feet.

9 They were brought down, led like beasts in constraints of iron bonds, some fastened by their necks to the beams of the ships, others secured by their feet in unbreakable fetters,

10 and with dense planking placed overhead also, so that, their eyes darkened on every side, they might receive the treatment of those plotted against throughout the whole voyage downstream.

11 When they were brought to the place called Schedia and the voyage was completed, as had been decreed by the king, he commanded them to encamp in the hippodrome before the city, which had an immense circumference and was most suitable for making a public example to all entering the city and those of them departing into the country on a journey, so that they might neither associate with his forces nor be deemed worthy of enclosures at all.

12 When this happened, hearing that their fellow countrymen from the city were coming out secretly more frequently to lament the inglorious misery of their brothers,

13 he became furious and commanded that these also be treated together carefully in the same manner as those, falling short of their punishment in no way,

14 and that the whole tribe be registered by name, not for the laborious service of work mentioned briefly a little before, but that, tortured by the ordered outrages, they should finally be annihilated within the space of one day.

15 Their registration therefore took place with bitter haste and ambitious persistence from sunrise until sunset for forty days, its completion remaining unaccomplished.

16 The king, greatly and continually filled with joy, held drinking parties before all the idols, with a mind wandering far from truth and a profane mouth, praising the dumb things unable to speak to them or aid them, but speaking things unfitting against the greatest God.

17 After the aforementioned interval of time, the scribes reported to the king that they were no longer able to make the registration of the Jews because of their immeasurable multitude,

18 although most were still throughout the country, some still gathered in houses and others in the locality, as the task had become impossible for all the generals over Egypt.

19 When he threatened them more harshly, as having been bribed to contrive an escape, it happened that he was clearly assured concerning this,

20 when they stated with proof that both the writing material and the writing reeds they used had already run out.

21 This was the working of the invincible providence of him who aids the Jews from heaven.

Chapter 5

1 Then, summoning Hermon, who attended to the care of the elephants, filled with heavy anger and wholly inflexible in his rage,

2 he commanded that for the coming day all the elephants, five hundred in number, be given abundant handfuls of frankincense and much unmixed wine to drink, and, made savage by the plentiful provision of the drink, be brought in to meet the doom of the Jews.

3 Giving these orders, he turned to the banquet, gathering those of the Friends and the army who were most hostile toward the Jews.

4 Hermon, the commander of the elephants, carried out the command firmly.

5 The servants attending these matters went out in the evening and bound the hands of the afflicted, and contrived the rest of their security for the night, thinking that the tribe would together receive the end of its destruction.

6 But the Jews, who seemed to the nations to be bereft of all protection because of the constraint encompassing them on every side with bonds,

7 all invoked with tears and a cry difficult to silence the Almighty Lord, who rules over every power, their merciful God and Father, begging

8 him to turn aside the impious purpose against them and rescue them by a magnificent manifestation from the doom ready at their feet.

9 Their supplication therefore ascended earnestly into heaven.

10 Hermon, having given drink to the pitiless elephants, filled with the plentiful supply of wine and saturated with frankincense, came to the palace early to report these things to the king.

11 But a portion of sleep, the beautiful creation from eternal time, bestowed in night and day by him who grants it to all whom he wishes, he sent upon the king,

12 and he was held in most pleasant and deep sleep by the working of the Master, greatly thwarted in his lawless purpose and greatly disappointed in his inflexible intention.

13 The Jews, escaping the previously indicated hour, praised their holy God and again asked him, readily reconciled, to show the might of his very powerful hand to arrogant nations.

14 When it was already nearly the middle of the tenth hour, the one assigned to the invitations, seeing the invited guests gathered together, approached and nudged the king.

15 Barely awakening him, he pointed out that the time for the drinking party was already passing, making his report about these things.

16 The king, considering it and turning to drinking, commanded those who had come to the drinking party to recline opposite him.

17 When this had happened, he urged them to give themselves to feasting and, being greatly honored, devote the present portion of the drinking party to gladness.

18 As the conversation proceeded further, the king summoned Hermon and with a bitter threat inquired for what reason the Jews had been allowed to survive the remaining day.

19 When he pointed out that he had brought the command to completion while it was still night, and the Friends also bore witness to him,

20 he, possessing cruelty worse than Phalaris, said that they owed thanks to today’s sleep; “But without delay prepare the elephants in the same manner for the following day, for the annihilation of the unlawful Jews.”

21 When the king had spoken, all those present gladly agreed together with joy, and each withdrew to his own house.

22 They used the time of night not so much for sleep as for devising every kind of mockery against those thought wretched.

23 The cock had just crowed early, and Hermon, having armed the beasts, was moving them about in the great colonnade.

24 The multitudes throughout the city had gathered for the most pitiable spectacle, eagerly awaiting the morning.

25 The Jews, their souls being drawn out at each indivisible moment, stretching their hands to heaven in a supplication full of tears and lamenting songs, begged the greatest God again to help them speedily.

26 The rays of the sun had not yet spread, and while the king awaited the Friends, Hermon came forward and called him to go out, pointing out that the king’s eager desire lay ready.

27 Receiving him and being astonished at the lawless departure, wholly possessed by ignorance, he inquired what the matter was for which this had been eagerly accomplished for him;

28 this was the working of God, who rules over all, having placed in his mind forgetfulness of the things previously contrived by him.

29 Hermon and all the Friends explained, “The beasts and the forces have been prepared, O king, according to your earnest purpose.”

30 Filled with heavy rage at what was said, because through God’s providence all his thought concerning these things had been scattered, he looked intently with a threat and said:

31 “Whatever parents were present or offspring of children, I would have prepared these as an abundant feast for wild beasts instead of the blameless Jews, who have shown exceptionally complete and steadfast faithfulness to me and my ancestors.

32 Indeed, were it not for the affection of our upbringing together and your service, you would have been deprived of life instead of these.”

33 Thus Hermon endured an unexpected dangerous threat, and shrank in gaze and countenance.

34 Each of the Friends slipped out gloomily, and they dismissed those gathered, each to his own occupation.

35 The Jews, hearing the things from the king, praised the manifest God, Lord, King of kings, having obtained this help from him also.

36 According to the same customs, the king assembled the whole drinking party and encouraged them to turn to gladness.

37 Summoning Hermon, he said with a threat, “How many times must I command you about these very things, most wretched man?

38 Arm the elephants yet again now for tomorrow, for the annihilation of the Jews.”

39 The kinsmen reclining with him, wondering at his unstable mind, put forward these words:

40 “O king, how long do you test us as irrational men, commanding now for the third time that they be annihilated, and again, when it comes to the matter, changing and dissolving your decrees?

41 Because of these things the city is disturbed by the expectation and, filled with gatherings, already often runs the risk of being plundered.”

42 Therefore the king, a Phalaris in every respect, filled with recklessness and regarding as nothing the changes of soul arising in him for the visitation of the Jews, firmly declaring a most unfulfilled oath, said that he would send them without delay to Hades, mangled by the knees and feet of beasts,

43 and, campaigning against Ioudaia, would quickly level it with fire and spear, and would swiftly cast their temple, inaccessible to us, headlong by fire, and make it bereft forever of those performing sacrifices there.

44 Then the Friends and kinsmen, departing overjoyed, confidently stationed the forces in the most suitable places of the city for guarding.

45 The commander of the elephants, having brought the beasts almost, so to speak, into a maddened condition with most fragrant drinks of wine infused with frankincense, fearfully adorned with equipment,

46 entered the palace around dawn, the city already filled with countless multitudes toward the hippodrome, and urged the king on to the matter proposed.

47 Filling his impious mind with heavy anger, he set out with all his weight together with the beasts, wishing with unwounded heart and the pupils of his eyes to behold the painful and miserable destruction of those previously indicated.

48 When the elephants were going out near the gate, and the armed force followed and the multitude marched, the Jews, seeing the dust and hearing the deep-sounding tumult,

49 thinking that this was their last moment of life, the end of their most wretched expectation, turned to compassion and lamentations and kissed one another, embracing their relatives and falling upon their necks, parents upon children and mothers upon young women, while others held newborn infants at their breasts, drawing milk for the last time.

50 Nevertheless, also perceiving the helps from heaven that had previously come to them, they threw themselves face down with one accord and separated the infants from their breasts,

51 and cried out with an exceedingly loud voice, supplicating the Sovereign of all power to pity them with a manifestation, already standing at the gates of Hades.

Chapter 6

1 A certain Eleazaros, a distinguished man among the priests from the country, already having attained old age and adorned with every virtue in life, quieted the elders around him to invoke the holy God, and prayed these things:

2 “King of great might, Most High, Almighty God, governing all creation with compassions,

3 look upon the seed of Abraam, upon the children of sanctified Iakob, the people of your sanctified portion, strangers in a foreign land being unjustly destroyed, O Father.

4 You destroyed Pharao, abounding in chariots, the former sovereign of this Egypt, lifted up with lawless audacity and a boastful tongue, together with his arrogant army, drowned in the sea, manifesting a light of mercy to the people of Israel.

5 You shattered Sennacherim, the grievous king of the Assyrians, elated by countless forces, already having taken all the earth under his hand by the spear and lifted up against your holy city, speaking grievous things with boasting and audacity; you, Master, showed your might manifest to many nations.

6 You rescued the three companions in Babylonia, who voluntarily gave their lives to fire so as not to serve vain things, cooling the fiery furnace and leaving them unharmed to a hair, sending flame upon all the adversaries.

7 You brought Daniel unharmed up into the light, who through envious slanders had been thrown underground to lions as food for beasts.

8 And, seeing Ionas wasting away in the belly of a sea creature nurtured in the depths, you showed him unharmed to all his own people, O Father.

9 And now, Hater of insolence, abundantly merciful Protector of all, quickly manifest yourself to those of the people of Israel, outraged by abhorred lawless nations.

10 If our life in our settlement abroad has become entangled in impieties, rescue us from the hand of enemies and destroy us by whatever fate you choose, Master.

11 Do not let the vain-minded bless vain things over the destruction of your beloved, saying, ‘Not even their God rescued them.’

12 But you, eternal One possessing all strength and all sovereignty, look now; have mercy on us, who are being removed from life by the reckless insolence of lawless men, in the manner of those plotted against.

13 Let nations cower before your invincible power today, honored One possessing power for the salvation of the people of Iakob.

14 The whole multitude of infants and their parents supplicate you with tears.

15 Let it be shown to all nations that you are with us, Lord, and have not turned your face away from us; but as you said, ‘Not even when they were in the land of their enemies did I overlook them,’ so accomplish it, Lord.”

16 As Eleazaros was just ending the prayer, the king came along toward the hippodrome with the beasts and all the arrogance of his force.

17 Seeing him, the Jews cried aloud greatly to heaven, so that the neighboring valleys also resounded and caused an uncontrollable terror in the whole camp.

18 Then the greatly glorious Almighty and true God, manifesting his holy face, opened the heavenly gates, from which two glorified angels of fearful appearance descended, visible to all except the Jews,

19 and stood against them and filled the force of the adversaries with turmoil and cowardice and bound them with immovable fetters.

20 The king’s body also became shuddering, and forgetfulness seized his fiercely angry audacity.

21 They turned the beasts against the armed forces following, and they trampled and destroyed them.

22 The king’s anger changed to compassion and tears concerning the things previously contrived by him.

23 For, hearing the cry and seeing them all face down for destruction, weeping, he threatened the Friends with anger, saying:

24 “You usurp kingship and have surpassed tyrants in cruelty, and already attempt to remove me myself, your benefactor, from office and from breath, secretly contriving things unprofitable for the kingdom.

25 Who, removing each from his home, irrationally gathered here those who faithfully held the fortifications of our country?

26 Who so lawlessly surrounded with outrages those who from the beginning surpassed all nations in every respect in goodwill toward us, and often underwent the worst dangers among men?

27 Loose, release the unjust bonds; send them to their own homes with peace, asking pardon for the things previously done.

28 Release the sons of the Almighty heavenly living God, who from our ancestors until now grants unhindered stability with glory to our affairs.”

29 He therefore spoke these things; and they, released in an indivisible moment, blessed their holy Savior God, having just escaped death.

30 Then the king, departing into the city, summoned the one over revenues and commanded that wines and the other supplies for a banquet be provided to the Jews for seven days, deciding that in the place where they had thought to receive destruction, in this place they should celebrate deliverance with all gladness.

31 Then those formerly reproached and near Hades, or rather having stepped upon it, instead of a bitter and grievously lamentable fate, held a drinking feast for deliverance and, full of joy, apportioned with reclining places the place prepared for their downfall and grave.

32 Ceasing the wholly lamentable melody of dirges, they took up an ancestral song, praising God, their Savior and Wonder-worker; and, dismissing all wailing and shrieking, they formed dances as a sign of peaceful gladness.

33 Likewise the king also, gathering a great drinking party for these things, continually made magnificent acknowledgment toward heaven for the unexpected deliverance that had occurred for him.

34 Those who formerly supposed that they would be destroyed and eaten by birds, and had registered them with joy, groaned, clothing themselves with shame, their fire-breathing audacity ingloriously extinguished.

35 The Jews, as we have said before, forming the aforementioned dance, passed their time with feasting in cheerful acknowledgments and psalms.

36 Determining a common ordinance concerning these things throughout their whole settlement abroad for generations, they established the observance of the aforementioned days with gladness, not for drinking and gluttony, but for the deliverance which had come to them through God.

37 They petitioned the king, asking for their release to their own homes.

38 They register them from the twenty-fifth of Pachon until the fourth of Epiphi, for forty days, and arrange their destruction from the fifth of Epiphi until the seventh, for three days,

39 in which the Sovereign of all, gloriously manifesting his mercy, rescued them all together without stumbling.

40 They feasted, everything being supplied by the king, until the fourteenth, on which they also made the petition concerning their release.

41 Agreeing with them, the king wrote for them the letter written below to the generals in each city, conveying his earnest concern magnanimously:

Chapter 7

1 “King Ptolemaios Philopator to the generals throughout Egypt and all those appointed over affairs, greetings and health;

2 we ourselves and our children are well, the great God having directed affairs for us as we choose.

3 Some of the Friends, through ill nature, persistently pressing upon us, persuaded us to gather the Jews under the kingdom as a body and punish them with extraordinary punishments of rebels,

4 asserting that our affairs would never be stable until this was accomplished, because of the hostility these men have toward all nations.

5 They brought them down bound with maltreatment, as slaves, or rather as plotters, and without any inquiry or examination attempted to kill them, having clothed themselves with cruelty more savage than the custom of Scythians.

6 But we, threatening them more harshly concerning these things, according to the equity we have toward all men, barely granting them life, and recognizing that the heavenly God has securely defended the Jews, continually fighting for them as a father for sons,

7 and considering the steadfast goodwill of a friend which they have toward us and our ancestors, have justly released them from every accusation in whatever manner,

8 and have commanded everyone that all should return to their own homes in every place, no one harming them at all or reproaching them for the things that happened contrary to reason.

9 For know that if we wickedly contrive any evil against these men or distress them at all, we will have opposing us, not a man, but the Most High God who rules over every power, for vengeance upon affairs, in every respect inescapably and continually. Farewell.”

10 Receiving this letter, they did not hasten immediately to attend to their departure, but further requested the king that those of the Jewish people who had voluntarily transgressed against the holy God and the law of God should receive through them the punishment owed,

11 asserting that those who had transgressed the divine ordinances for the sake of the belly would never be well-disposed even toward the king’s affairs.

12 He, accepting that they spoke the truth and approving, gave them permission for everything, so that they might openly destroy those who had transgressed God’s law throughout every place under his kingdom, without any royal authorization or oversight.

13 Then, acclaiming him as was fitting, their priests and the whole multitude shouted the allelouia and departed with joy.

14 Thus they punished any defiled fellow countryman they encountered along the road and killed them with public examples.

15 On that day they killed more than three hundred men, and celebrated it with gladness and joy, having subdued the profane.

16 Those who themselves had held to God until death, receiving complete enjoyment of deliverance, departed from the city crowned with every kind of most fragrant flower, with gladness and shouting, in praises and hymns of every melody, giving thanks to the God of their fathers, the eternal Savior of Israel.

17 Arriving in Ptolemais, called rose-bearing because of the character of the place, where the fleet waited for them seven days according to their common decision,

18 they held there a drinking feast for deliverance, the king having generously supplied them with everything for each one’s arrival as far as his own home.

19 Landing with peace and fitting acknowledgments, they likewise established there also the observance of these days with gladness during the time of their settlement abroad.

20 Consecrating these days on a pillar and establishing a place of prayer at the place of the drinking party, they departed unharmed, free, exceedingly joyful, brought safely back by land and sea and river at the king’s command, each to his own home,

21 and possessing much greater authority among their enemies than before, with glory and fear, being deprived of none of their possessions by extortion at all.

22 All recovered all their own things according to the registration, so that those who possessed anything restored it to them with the greatest fear, the greatest God having perfectly accomplished great deeds for their deliverance.

23 Blessed is the Rescuer of Israel for all time. Amen.

4 Maccabees

Chapter 1

1 About to present a most philosophical discourse, whether pious reason is sovereign over the passions, I would rightly advise you to attend eagerly to philosophy.

2 For the discourse is necessary for knowledge to everyone, and moreover contains praise of the greatest virtue, I mean prudence.

3 If therefore reason appears to prevail over the passions hindering temperance, both gluttony and desire,

4 it also manifestly rules over the passions obstructing justice, such as ill nature, and the passions obstructing courage, anger and fear and pain.

5 “How then,” some might perhaps say, “if reason masters the passions, does it not rule over forgetfulness and ignorance?” attempting to say something ridiculous.

6 For reason does not master its own passions, but those opposed to justice and courage and temperance, and these not so as to abolish them, but so as not to yield to them.

7 From many sources and elsewhere I could therefore show you that reason is ruler over the passions,

8 but much more could I demonstrate this from the valor of those who died for virtue, Eleazaros and the seven brothers and their mother.

9 For all these, disregarding pains unto death, demonstrated that reason completely masters the passions.

10 For their virtues therefore it falls to me to praise the men who at this time died with their mother for nobility and goodness, and for their honors I would call them blessed.

11 For, admired not only by all men for their courage and endurance, but also by their tormentors, they became responsible for the overthrow of the tyranny against the nation, conquering the tyrant by endurance, so that the homeland was purified through them.

12 But it will be possible to speak about this presently also, beginning with the subject, as I am accustomed to do; and thus I will turn to the discourse concerning them, giving glory to the all-wise God.

13 We therefore inquire whether reason is ruler over the passions.

14 We distinguish what reason is and what passion is, and how many forms of passions there are, and whether reason prevails over all these.

15 Reason therefore is a mind which with right reasoning prefers the life of wisdom.

16 Wisdom therefore is knowledge of divine and human matters and their causes.

17 This therefore is the instruction of the law, through which we learn divine matters reverently and human matters profitably.

18 The forms of wisdom are prudence and justice and courage and temperance;

19 most authoritative of all is prudence, through which reason prevails over the passions.

20 The two most comprehensive natures of passions are pleasure and pain; each of these naturally concerns both body and soul.

21 There are also many sequences of passions concerning pleasure and pain.

22 Before pleasure therefore is desire, and after pleasure joy.

23 Before pain is fear, and after pain grief.

24 Anger is a passion common to pleasure and pain, if one considers that he has fallen into it.

25 In pleasure there is also the ill-natured disposition, which is the most varied of all passions,

26 and those of the soul are arrogance and love of money and love of glory and contentiousness and envy,

27 and concerning the body, eating everything and greediness and eating alone.

28 As therefore there are two plants of body and soul, pleasure and pain, there are many offshoots of these plants,

29 each of which reason, the universal cultivator, cleanses and prunes and binds and waters and tends in every manner, taming the woodlands of dispositions and passions.

30 For reason is leader of the virtues and ruler of the passions. Observe therefore first, through the deeds hindering temperance, that reason is sovereign over the passions.

31 Temperance therefore is mastery of desires,

32 and of desires some belong to the soul and others to the body, and reason appears to prevail over both these.

33 For why, when moved toward forbidden foods, do we turn away from their pleasures? Is it not because reason can prevail over appetites? I think so.

34 Therefore, desiring aquatic creatures and birds and quadrupeds and every kind of food forbidden us according to the law, we abstain through the mastery of reason.

35 For the passions of appetites are restrained, checked by the temperate mind, and all the movements of the body are muzzled by reason.

Chapter 2

1 And what is wondrous if the desires of the soul for participation in beauty are annulled?

2 In this respect therefore the temperate Ioseph is praised, because by thought he completely mastered sensual pleasure.

3 For, being young and in his prime for intercourse, he annulled by reason the frenzy of the passions.

4 Reason appears to prevail not only over the maddening impulse of sensual pleasure, but also over every desire.

5 The law therefore says, “You shall not desire your neighbor’s wife, nor whatever belongs to your neighbor.”

6 And indeed, since the law has told us not to desire, I could much more persuade you that reason can master desires. Likewise also the passions hindering justice;

7 for in what manner is someone whose character is to eat alone and be gluttonous, or also drunken, reeducated, unless it is clear that reason is master of the passions?

8 For immediately, conducting his life by the law, even if someone loves money, he constrains his own manner, lending to those in need without interest and canceling the loan when the seventh periods arrive;

9 and even if someone is miserly, he is mastered by the law through reason, neither gleaning his harvests nor gathering the remaining grapes of his vineyards. In the other matters also it is possible to recognize this, that reason masters the passions;

10 for the law also masters goodwill toward parents, not betraying virtue for their sake,

11 and prevails over affection toward a wife, reproving her because of lawlessness,

12 and rules over affection for children, punishing them because of wickedness,

13 and governs familiarity with friends, exposing them because of evil.

14 And do not suppose it unexpected, since reason can also prevail over enmity through the law, neither cutting down the cultivated plants of enemies, but preserving the things of enemies for those who lost them and helping raise those that have fallen.

15 Reason also appears to master the more violent passions, love of rule and vainglory and arrogance and boasting and envy;

16 for the temperate mind repels all these ill-natured passions, as also anger; for it rules over this also.

17 Indeed Moyses, angry against Dathan and Abiron, did nothing against them in anger, but regulated his anger by reason.

18 For the temperate mind is able, as I said, to excel against the passions and alter some of them, and also annul others.

19 For why does our all-wise father Iakob blame those around Symeon and Leui, who slaughtered the Sikimites as a whole nation without reason, saying, “Accursed is their anger”?

20 For if reason could not master anger, he would not have spoken thus.

21 For when God fashioned man, he planted his passions and dispositions around him;

22 and when he enthroned above all the holy leader, the mind, through the organs of sense,

23 he also gave it a law, according to which, conducting its life, it will reign with a temperate and just and good and courageous reign.

24 “How then,” someone might say, “if reason is master of the passions, does it not master forgetfulness and ignorance?”

Chapter 3

1 But the argument is altogether ridiculous; for reason appears to prevail not over its own passions, but over those of the body.

2 For example, none of us can cut out desire, but reason can provide that one not be enslaved to desire.

3 One cannot cut anger out of your soul, but it is possible for reason to help with anger.

4 None of us can cut out ill nature, but reason could fight alongside us so that we not be bent by ill nature;

5 for reason is not an uprooter of the passions, but an antagonist.

6 It is therefore possible to consider this more clearly through the thirst of King Dauid.

7 For when Dauid, attacking the foreigners throughout a whole day, killed many of them with the soldiers of the nation,

8 then, when evening came, sweating and exceedingly weary, he came to the royal tent, around which the whole army of our ancestors had encamped.

9 All the others therefore were at supper,

10 but the king, exceedingly thirsty, although having abundant springs, could not cure his thirst through them,

11 but an irrational desire for the water among the enemies intensified and parched him, and weakened and burned him.

12 Therefore, when the shield-bearers lamented the king’s desire, two young strong soldiers, respecting the king’s desire, armed themselves with their full equipment and, taking a pitcher, crossed the enemies’ palisades,

13 and, escaping the notice of the guards at the gates, went through, searching throughout the whole camp of the enemies,

14 and, discovering the spring, boldly brought the drink from it to the king;

15 but he, although burning with thirst, reasoned that a drink reckoned equivalent to blood was a most terrible danger to the soul,

16 and therefore, setting reason against desire, poured the drink as a libation to God.

17 For the temperate mind is able to conquer the compulsions of the passions and extinguish the inflammations of frenzy,

18 and wrestle down the exceedingly great pains of bodies, and through the nobility and goodness of reason spit away all the dominions of the passions.

19 Now the occasion also calls us to the demonstration from history of temperate reason.

20 For since our fathers had deep peace through good observance of law and prospered, so that even Seleukos Nikanor, king of Asia, allotted them money for sacred service and accepted their constitution,

21 then some, introducing innovations against the common concord, experienced manifold calamities.

Chapter 4

1 For a certain Simon, opposing Onias, who then held the high priesthood for life, a fine and good man, since by slandering in every manner he was unable to harm him before the nation, went away as a fugitive to betray the homeland.

2 Therefore, coming to Apollonios, the general of Syria and Phoinike and Kilikia, he said:

3 “Being well-disposed toward the king’s affairs, I come reporting that many tens of thousands in private funds have been stored in the treasuries of Hierosolyma, not belonging to the sacred funds, and that these belong to King Seleukos.”

4 Learning each of these things, Apollonios praises Simon for his care toward the king, and, going up to Seleukos, reported the treasure of funds.

5 Receiving authority concerning them, quickly into our homeland with the accursed Simon and a most grievous army,

6 he came and said he had arrived by the king’s commands to take the private funds of the treasury.

7 The nation lamented and objected to the statement, and, considering it most terrible if those who entrusted deposits to the sacred treasury should be deprived, they prevented him as far as possible.

8 But Apollonios went into the sanctuary with threats.

9 When the priests with women and children in the sanctuary supplicated God to defend the sacred place being treated with contempt,

10 and Apollonios went up with his fully armed army to seize the funds, mounted angels appeared beforehand from heaven, flashing all around with their arms and instilling much fear and trembling in them.

11 Indeed Apollonios, falling half dead upon the sanctuary’s enclosure for all tribes, stretched his hands toward heaven and with tears exhorted the Hebrews to pray for him and appease the heavenly army.

12 For he said that he had sinned so as to deserve even death, and that, if saved, he would hymn to all men the blessedness of the sacred place.

13 Moved by these words, Onias the high priest, although also wary lest King Seleukos suppose that Apollonios had been killed by a human plot and not divine justice, prayed for him.

14 Unexpectedly preserved, he departed to make known to the king what had happened to him.

15 When King Seleukos died, his son Antiochos Epiphanes succeeds to the rule, an arrogant and terrible man,

16 who removed Onias from the high priesthood and established his brother Iason as high priest,

17 who agreed to give three thousand six hundred and sixty talents yearly if he entrusted the office to him.

18 He permitted him both to serve as high priest and to lead the nation;

19 and he changed the nation’s way of life and constitution toward every lawlessness,

20 so that he not only constructed a gymnasium upon the very citadel of our homeland, but also dissolved the care of the sanctuary.

21 Indignant at these things, divine justice made Antiochos himself wage war against them.

22 For when he was warring in Egypt against Ptolemaios, and heard that, a report of his death having spread, the Hierosolymites rejoiced exceedingly, he quickly marched against them,

23 and, when he had ravaged them, made a decree that if any of them were found conducting their lives by the ancestral law, they should die.

24 Since he was in no way able through the decrees to overthrow the nation’s good observance of law, but saw all his threats and punishments being overthrown,

25 so that even women, because they circumcised their children, were hurled down with their infants, knowing beforehand that they would suffer this;

26 since therefore his decrees were despised by the people, he himself through tortures compelled each individual of the nation to renounce Judaism by tasting polluted foods.

Chapter 5

1 Indeed the tyrant Antiochos, taking his seat with the councilors upon a certain high place, with his armed troops standing around him,

2 commanded the spear-bearers to drag forward each Hebrew and compel him to taste pork and food sacrificed to idols;

3 and if any were unwilling to eat polluted food, these should be tortured on the wheel and killed.

4 Many being seized together, one first from the crowd, named Eleazaros, a priest by birth, learned in the law and advanced in age, and known to many around the tyrant because of his age, was brought near him.

5 Seeing him, Antiochos said:

6 “Before beginning the tortures against you, old man, I would advise you these things, that by tasting pork you might be saved;

7 for I respect your age and gray hair, which you have after so long a time, yet you do not seem to me to practice philosophy, using the religion of the Jews.

8 For why do you abhor eating the flesh of this animal, when nature has granted it as most excellent?

9 For this is senseless, not to enjoy pleasant things without reproach, and unjust to turn away the gifts of nature.

10 And you seem to me likely to act even more senselessly if, vainly boasting concerning the truth, you further despise me also to your own punishment.

11 Will you not awaken from your prattling philosophy and scatter the nonsense from your reasonings, and, taking up a mind worthy of your age, philosophize upon the truth of what is advantageous,

12 and, reverencing my humane counsel, pity your own old age?

13 For consider that, even if there is some overseeing power of this religion of yours, it would pardon you for every transgression arising through compulsion."

14 When the tyrant urged him in this manner toward unlawful eating of flesh, Eleazaros asked to speak,

15 and, receiving permission to speak, began to address them thus:

16 "We, Antiochos, persuaded to conduct our life by divine law, consider no compulsion stronger than our obedience to the law;

17 therefore we deem it proper in no manner to transgress the law.

18 Indeed, if our law were not in truth divine, as you suppose, but we otherwise considered it divine, even so it would not be permissible for us to annul our conviction concerning piety.

19 Do not therefore suppose that this would be a small sin, if we ate polluted food;

20 for transgressing the law in small and great things is equivalent,

21 for through either the law is similarly treated with arrogance.

22 You mock our philosophy as though we did not live in it with sound reasoning;

23 for it teaches us temperance so as to master all pleasures and desires, and trains courage so as willingly to endure every pain,

24 and instructs in justice so as to practice equality of law in all dispositions, and teaches piety so as magnificently to revere only the God who exists.

25 Therefore we do not eat polluted food; for, believing that the law is established by God, we know that the Creator of the world sympathizes with us according to nature in legislating;

26 he permitted us to eat what would be suited to our souls, but forbade the eating of flesh of what would be opposed to them.

27 It is tyrannical not only to compel us to transgress the law, but also to eat, so that you may laugh at us for this most hateful eating of polluted food.

28 But you will not laugh this laugh against me,

29 nor will I abandon the holy oaths of the ancestors concerning keeping the law,

30 not even if you cut out my eyes and melt my entrails.

31 I am not so old and cowardly that through piety my reason does not remain youthful.

32 Therefore prepare wheels and blow the fire more fiercely.

33 I do not pity my own old age so much that through myself I would overthrow the ancestral law.

34 I will not betray you, instructing law, nor renounce you, beloved self-control,

35 nor shame you, philosophical reason, nor deny you, honored priesthood and knowledge of legislation;

36 nor will you defile my reverent mouth of old age or my lifetime of lawful life.

37 The fathers will receive me pure, not having feared your compulsions unto death.

38 For you will tyrannize over the impious, but will rule over my reasonings for piety neither by words nor through deeds.”

Chapter 6

1 When he had answered the tyrant's exhortations in this manner, the guards standing by dragged Eleazaros bitterly to the instruments of torture.

2 And first they stripped the aged man, adorned with the dignity belonging to piety;

3 then, binding his arms behind him, they maltreated him with whips on either side,

4 while a herald cried out from the other side, “Obey the king's commands.”

5 But Eleazaros, truly magnanimous and noble, as though being tortured in a dream, did not change in any way,

6 but, raising his eyes high toward heaven, the old man had his flesh torn by the whips and was drenched with blood, and his sides were pierced through.

7 And falling to the ground because his body could not bear the pains, he kept his reason upright and unbending.

8 Indeed, one of the bitter guards, springing at his flanks, struck him with his foot so that he would rise when falling.

9 But he endured the pains and despised the compulsion and persisted through the maltreatments,

10 and, like a noble athlete, the old man, while being struck, defeated those torturing him;

11 indeed, sweating in the face and panting heavily, he was admired even by those torturing him for his courage.

12 Therefore, partly pitying the circumstances of his old age,

13 partly feeling sympathy from familiarity, and partly admiring his endurance, some of the king's men approached him and said,

14 “Why do you unreasonably destroy yourself with these evils, Eleazar?

15 We will indeed set before you some of the cooked foods, and you, pretending to taste the pork, save yourself.”

16 And Eleazaros, as though more bitterly maltreated by the counsel, cried out,

17 “May we, the children of Abraam, not think so badly as to become fainthearted and act out a performance unfitting for us.

18 For it is also unreasonable if, having lived our life until old age according to truth and lawfully guarded the reputation belonging to it, we should now change

19 and we ourselves should become a pattern of impiety to the young, so that we become an example of eating defiled food.

20 And it is shameful if we shall live on for a little time, and that while being laughed at by everyone for cowardice,

21 and be despised by the tyrant as unmanly, but should not defend our divine law until death.

22 In view of these things, you, children of Abraam, die nobly for piety.

23 And you guards of the tyrant, why do you delay?”

24 Seeing him thus magnanimous in the face of the compulsions and not changing even in response to their pity, they led him up to the fire;

25 there, burning him with maliciously devised instruments, they flung him about, and poured foul-smelling liquids into his nostrils.

26 But he, already burned down to his bones and about to faint, raised his eyes toward God and said,

27 “You know, God, that although I can save myself, I am dying in burning tortures because of the law.

28 Be gracious to your nation, being satisfied with our punishment on their behalf.

29 Make my blood their purification, and take my life as an exchange for their lives.”

30 And having said these things, the holy man died nobly in the tortures, and until the tortures of death resisted by reason because of the law.

31 Therefore, admittedly, pious reason is master of the passions.

32 For if the passions had prevailed over reason, we would have given them the testimony of supremacy;

33 but now, since reason has defeated the passions, we suitably assign to it the authority of leadership.

34 And it is just for us to acknowledge that the might belongs to reason, since it prevails even over pains from outside, for it is also ridiculous.

35 And I demonstrate that reason has not only prevailed over pains, but also rules pleasures and yields nothing to them.

Chapter 7

1 For like an excellent pilot, the reason of our father Eleazaros, steering the ship of piety in the sea of the passions

2 and being maltreated by the tyrant's threats and flooded by the stormy waves of the tortures,

3 did not in any way turn the tillers of piety until it sailed into the harbor of immortal victory.

4 No city, besieged with many and varied engines, ever held out in this way, as did that most holy man. Being set on fire in his sacred soul with maltreatments and racks, he defeated those besieging him through reason, which defends piety.

5 For father Eleazar, extending his own understanding like a headland with steep cliffs, broke the raging surges of the passions.

6 O priest worthy of the priesthood, you did not defile your sacred teeth, nor did you profane with defiled eating the belly that had made room for reverence for God and purification.

7 O one in accord with the law and philosopher of divine life.

8 Such must be those who put the law into practice, defending it with their own blood and noble sweat against sufferings unto death.

9 You, father, confirmed our observance of law unto glory through your endurance, and, having spoken reverently of holiness, you did not overthrow it, and through deeds you made credible the discourses of your divine philosophy,

10 O old man more forceful than tortures, aged man stronger than fire, and greatest king of the passions, Eleazar.

11 For just as father Aaron, armed with the censer and running through the multitude of the nation, defeated the burning angel,

12 so Eleazar, the descendant of Aaron, being melted away by the fire, did not change his reason.

13 And indeed, most wondrous of all, although an old man, with the tensions of his body already loosened, his flesh slackened all around, and his sinews also exhausted, he became young again

14 in spirit through reason, and through reason like Isaak's he rendered the many-headed rack powerless.

15 O blessed old age and venerable gray hair and lawful life, which a faithful seal of death brought to completion.

16 If, therefore, an old man despised tortures unto death because of piety, admittedly pious reason is leader of the passions.

17 But perhaps some might say, “Not everyone masters the passions, because not everyone has prudent reason.”

18 But all who take thought for piety with their whole heart, these alone can rule the passions of the flesh,

19 believing that they do not die to God, just as neither do our patriarchs Abraam and Isaak and Iakob, but they live to God.

20 Therefore, the fact that some appear to be ruled by passions because of weak reason presents no opposition;

21 for who, pursuing philosophy according to the whole rule of philosophy and having trusted God,

22 and knowing that it is blessed to endure every pain because of virtue, would not master the passions because of reverence for God?

23 For the wise and courageous man alone is lord of the passions.

Chapter 8

1 Indeed, for this reason youths also, pursuing philosophy by the reason of piety, prevailed over harsher instruments of torture.

2 For when, at the first trial, the tyrant was conspicuously defeated, being unable to compel an old man to eat defiled food, then, with exceedingly great passion, he commanded that others be brought from the captive Hebrews, and that, if they ate defiled food, they be released after eating, but if they spoke against it, they be tortured more bitterly.

3 When the tyrant had ordered these things, seven brothers were brought in with an aged mother, handsome and modest and noble and gracious in everything.

4 Seeing them surrounding their mother in the middle, as in a chorus, the tyrant took pleasure in them, and, struck by their good appearance and nobility, smiled at them and called them near and said,

5 “O young men, I admire each one of you with goodwill; esteeming highly the beauty and the number of so many brothers, I not only counsel you not to go mad with the same madness as the old man tortured before you, but also urge you to yield to me and enjoy my friendship;

6 and just as I could punish those disobeying my commands, so also could I benefit those readily obeying me.

7 Trust, therefore, and you will receive leading offices over my affairs, having denied your ancestral ordinance of citizenship;

8 and, having partaken of Greek life and changed your way of living, luxuriate in your youth;

9 for if you make me angry through disobedience, you will compel me, with dreadful punishments, to destroy each one of you through tortures.

10 Have pity on yourselves, therefore, whom even I, your enemy, pity for your age and beauty.

11 Will you not consider this, that if you disobey, nothing is laid up for you except to die with tortures?”

12 Saying these things, he commanded that the instruments of torture be placed before them, so that through fear also he might persuade them to eat defiled food.

13 And when the guards had set out wheels and joint-presses, racks and rollers and catapults and cauldrons, frying pans and finger-sheaths and iron hands and wedges and the glowing embers of the fire, the tyrant took up the speech and said,

14 “Youths, be afraid, and the justice you revere will be gracious to you when you transgress the law through compulsion.”

15 But they, hearing enticing things and seeing dreadful things, not only were not afraid, but also answered the tyrant with philosophy and through sound reasoning overthrew his tyranny.

16 And indeed, let us consider: if some among them had been cowardly and unmanly, what words would they have used? Would they not have been these?

17 “O wretched and exceedingly senseless us! Since the king calls us and invites us to benefits if we should obey him,

18 why do we delight ourselves with empty wishes and dare death-bearing disobedience?

19 Shall we not fear the instruments of torture, men, brothers, and consider the threats of tortures, and flee this vainglory and destruction-bearing arrogance?

20 Let us pity our own ages and have compassion on our mother's old age,

21 and reflect that, if we disobey, we shall be dead.

22 And divine justice also will forgive us for fearing the king through compulsion.

23 Why do we lead ourselves out of sweetest life and deprive ourselves of the sweet world?

24 Let us not contend by force against compulsion, nor be vainglorious over our own torture.

25 Neither does the law itself willingly put us to death for fearing the instruments of torture.

26 From where has such great contentiousness melted into us, and why does death-bearing endurance please us, when it is possible to live without disturbance by obeying the king?”

27 But the young men about to be tortured neither said nor considered any of these things.

28 For they were disdainful of the passions and sovereign over the pains,

29 so that, as soon as the tyrant ceased counseling them to eat defiled food, they all said together with one voice, as though from the same soul,

Chapter 9

1 “Why do you delay, tyrant? For we are ready to die rather than transgress our ancestral commandments;

2 for we would rightly be ashamed before our forefathers if we did not employ obedience to the law and Moyses as counselor.

3 Tyrant, counselor of lawlessness, do not, while hating us, pity us beyond ourselves.

4 For we consider your pity concerning our unlawful preservation to be harsher than death itself.

5 And you terrify us by threatening us with death through tortures, as though you had not learned from Eleazaros a little while ago.

6 But if the old men of the Hebrews practiced piety by enduring even tortures because of piety, more justly would we young men die, disregarding the tortures of your compulsions, which our aged instructor also defeated.

7 Make trial, therefore, tyrant; and if you put our lives to death because of piety, do not think you harm us by torturing us.

8 For through this suffering and endurance we shall have the prizes of virtue and shall be with God, because of whom we also suffer;

9 but because of your bloodshed against us, you will endure sufficient eternal torture by fire from divine justice.”

10 When they had said these things, the tyrant not only raged against them as disobedient, but also became angry against them as ungrateful.

11 Therefore, having been commanded, the shield-bearers brought forward the eldest of them, and, tearing his tunic, bound his hands and arms with straps on either side.

12 And when they grew weary of striking him with whips, accomplishing nothing, they threw him up onto the wheel;

13 stretched upon it, the noble young man was being dislocated.

14 And being broken in every limb, he reviled him, saying,

15 “Most defiled tyrant and enemy of heavenly justice and savage-minded one, you maltreat me in this manner although I have not murdered nor acted impiously, but defend divine law.”

16 And when the guards said, “Agree to eat, so that you may be released from the tortures,”

17 he said, “Your wheel is not so strong, defiled servants, as to strangle my reason; cut my limbs and burn my flesh and rack my joints.

18 For through all the tortures I will convince you that the children of the Hebrews alone are invincible for virtue.”

19 As he said these things, they spread fire beneath him and tightened further what set the wheel in motion;

20 and the wheel was stained everywhere with blood, and the heap of charcoal was being quenched by drops of bodily fluids, and his flesh flowed around the axles of the instrument.

21 And already having the framework of his bones cut all around, the magnanimous young man of Abraam did not groan,

22 but, as though being transformed in fire into incorruption, nobly endured the racks,

23 saying, “Imitate me, brothers; do not desert my contest, nor disown my brotherhood of courage.

24 Wage a sacred and noble campaign for piety, through which our just and ancestral providence, becoming gracious to the nation, might punish the accursed tyrant.”

25 And having said these things, the young man worthy of holiness breathed out his soul.

26 And while everyone admired his steadfastness of soul, the guards brought the second in age after the first, and, fitting iron hands with sharp claws, bound him to an instrument and catapult.

27 And when, asking whether he wished to eat before being tortured, they heard his noble resolve,

28 pulling with the iron hands from the sinews as far as the cheeks, the leopard-like beasts dragged away all his flesh and the skin of his head. But he, enduring this grievous pain, said,

29 “How sweet is every manner of death because of our ancestral piety.” And he said to the tyrant,

30 “Do you not think, cruelest tyrant of all, that you are being tortured more than I, seeing your arrogant reason of tyranny defeated by our endurance because of piety?

31 For I lighten my pain with the pleasures arising from virtue,

32 but you are tortured among the threats of impiety. And you will not escape, most defiled tyrant, the punishments of divine wrath.”

Chapter 10

1 And when this one had endured the death celebrated in song, the third was brought, being urged much by many to save himself by tasting.

2 But he cried out and said, “Do you not know that the same father begot me as those who died, and the same mother gave birth to me, and I was brought up in the same teachings?

3 I do not disown the noble kinship of the brotherhood.”

5 But they, taking the man's frank speech bitterly, dislocated his hands and feet with joint-pressing instruments, and, levering them out of their joints, tore his limbs apart,

6 and broke his fingers and arms and legs and elbows all around.

7 And being unable in any way to strangle him, they loosened the instruments and scalped him along with the very tips of his fingers.

8 And immediately they brought him onto the wheel, upon which, being torn apart at the vertebrae, he saw his own flesh torn all around and drops of blood flowing down over his entrails.

9 And being about to die, he said,

10 “We, most defiled tyrant, suffer these things because of the instruction and virtue of God;

11 but you, because of impiety and bloodshed, will endure tortures that cannot be ended.”

12 And when this one had died in a manner worthy of his brothers, they dragged forward the fourth, saying,

13 “Do not you also go mad with the same madness as your brothers, but obey the king and save yourself.”

14 But he said to them, “You do not have fire so much more burning against me as to make me act cowardly.

15 By the blessed death of my brothers and the eternal destruction of the tyrant and the everlasting life of the pious, I will not deny the noble brotherhood.

16 Devise tortures, tyrant, so that through them also you may learn that I am a brother of those tortured before me.”

17 Hearing these things, the blood-devouring and murderous and utterly most defiled Antiochos commanded that his tongue be cut out.

18 But he said, “Even if you take away the instrument of the voice, God hears even those who are silent;

19 look, the tongue is stretched out; cut it, for you will not thereby cut out the tongue of our reason.

20 Gladly we have the limbs of our body mutilated for God.

21 But God will swiftly pursue you, for you cut out the tongue that sings divine hymns.”

Chapter 11

1 And when this one also, maltreated by the tortures, died in them, the fifth sprang forward, saying,

2 “I am not going to beg off from torture for virtue, tyrant,

3 but I came forward myself, of my own accord, so that, killing me also, you may owe heavenly justice punishment for more wrongdoings.

4 O hater of virtue and hater of humanity, what have we done that you ravage us in this manner?

5 Is it because we reverence the creator of all and live according to his virtuous law?

6 But these things are worthy of honors, not tortures.”

9 And as he said such things, the guards bound him and dragged him onto the catapult,

10 upon which, binding him at the knees and fitting these into iron foot-traps, they bent his waist around a wedge on the wheel, around which, being bent backward in his entirety around the wheel in the manner of a scorpion, he was being torn limb from limb.

11 In this manner, being constricted in breath and strangled in body also,

12 he said, “Unwillingly you grant us fine favors, tyrant, providing us through nobler pains the opportunity to show our endurance toward the law.”

13 And when this one also had died, the sixth youth was brought, who, when the tyrant asked whether he wished to eat and be released, said,

14 “I am younger than my brothers in age, but of their age in understanding;

15 for having been born and brought up for the same things, we also ought likewise to die for the same things;

16 so, if it seems good to you to torture one who does not eat defiled food, torture.”

17 When he had said these things, they brought him onto the wheel,

18 upon which, being carefully stretched and having his vertebrae dislocated, he was burned from beneath.

19 And heating sharp skewers, they applied them to his back and, piercing his sides, burned through his entrails.

20 But while being tortured he said, “O contest worthy of holiness, to which so many brothers were called because of piety for an exercise in pains, and we were not defeated.

21 For pious knowledge is invincible, tyrant.

22 Armed with nobility and goodness, I too shall die with my brothers,

23 myself also bringing a great avenging spirit against you, inventor of tortures and enemy of those who truly practice piety.

24 Six youths have overthrown your tyranny;

25 for is your inability to persuade our reason to change or to force it toward defiled eating not your overthrow?

26 Your fire is cold to us, and the catapults painless, and your force powerless.

27 For our guards have stood in defense of divine law, not of a tyrant; because of this we have invincible reason.”

Chapter 12

1 And when this one also died blessedly, having been thrown into a cauldron, the seventh, youngest of all, came forward.

2 Pitying him, although terribly reviled by his brothers, and seeing the bonds already placed around him, the tyrant summoned him nearer and tried to exhort him, saying,

3 “You see the end of your brothers' madness; for, racked because of disobedience, they are dead.

4 But if you do not obey, wretched one, you too will be tortured and will be dead before your time,

5 but if you obey, you will be a friend and will lead the affairs of the kingdom.”

6 And urging these things, he summoned the child's mother, so that, pitying her who had been deprived of so many sons, he might urge the remaining one toward saving obedience.

7 But when his mother had exhorted him in the Hebrew tongue, as we shall say a little later,

8 he says, “Release me, that I may speak to the king and all the friends with him.”

9 And exceedingly pleased at the child's promise, they quickly released him.

10 And running near the frying pans,

11 he says, “Unholy tyrant and most impious of all wicked men, having received good things and the kingdom from God, were you not ashamed to kill his servants and rack those who exercise piety?

12 In return for these things, justice will reserve you for more intense and eternal fire and tortures, which will not release you for the whole age.

13 Were you not ashamed, being human, most beastly one, to cut out the tongues of those with like feelings and made from the same elements, and to torture them, maltreating them in this manner?

14 But they, dying nobly, fulfilled their piety toward God, while you will wail grievously for killing the contenders for virtue without cause.”

15 Therefore, being about to die himself also, he said,

16 “I do not desert the valor of my brothers;

17 but I call upon the ancestral God, that he may become gracious to our nation.

18 And he will punish you both in the present life and when you have died.”

19 And having prayed these things, he threw himself onto the frying pans, and thus gave up his life.

Chapter 13

1 If, therefore, the seven brothers despised pains unto death, it is agreed from every side that pious reason is sovereign master of the passions.

2 For if, enslaved to the passions, they had eaten defiled food, we would say that they had been defeated by them;

3 but now it was not so; rather, by reason praised before God, they overcame the passions,

4 and their leadership of understanding cannot be overlooked, for they prevailed over both passion and pains.

5 How, therefore, can one fail to acknowledge in these men sound reasoning's rule over the passions, when they did not turn back from the pains through fire?

6 For just as towers projecting at harbors, checking the threats of the waves, provide a calm anchorage for those sailing in,

7 so the seven-towered sound reasoning of the young men, fortifying the harbor of piety, defeated the licentiousness of the passions.

8 For, forming a sacred chorus of piety, they encouraged one another, saying,

9 “Let us die as brothers, brothers, for the law; let us imitate the three young men in Assyria, who despised the furnace that shared their citizenship.

10 Let us not act cowardly in the demonstration of piety.”

11 And one said, “Take courage, brother,” and another, “Endure nobly,”

12 and another, recalling, said, “Remember where you are from, or by the hand of what father Isaak endured being slaughtered because of piety.”

13 And each one, all together looking at one another, cheerful and very courageous, said, “Let us dedicate ourselves with the whole heart to God, who gave our lives, and let us lend our bodies to the guarding of the law.

14 Let us not fear the one who seems to kill;

15 for great is the contest of the soul and the danger lying in eternal torture for those who transgress the commandment of God.

16 Let us therefore arm ourselves with divine reason's rule over the passions.

17 For when we have died in this manner, Abraam and Isaak and Iakob will receive us, and all the fathers will praise us.”

18 And to each one of their brothers being dragged away, those remaining said, “Do not put us to shame, brother, nor prove false to our brothers who died before us.”

19 And you are not ignorant of the affections of brotherhood, which divine and all-wise providence apportioned through fathers to those being born, having planted them also through the maternal womb,

20 in which brothers dwelt for an equal time and were formed in the same time and grew from the same blood and were brought to completion through the same soul,

21 and were delivered after equal periods and drank milk from the same springs, from which embraces brother-loving souls are nourished together;

22 and they grow more strongly through upbringing together and daily familiarity and the other instruction and our exercise in God's law.

23 Thus, therefore, brotherly love being established in sympathy, the seven brothers had greater sympathy toward one another.

24 For, instructed in the same law and having exercised the same virtues and been brought up together in righteous life, they loved one another more.

25 For shared zeal for nobility and goodness intensified their goodwill and concord toward one another;

26 for together with piety they made brotherly love more desirable to themselves.

27 But nevertheless, although nature and familiarity and the habits of virtue increased the affections of brotherhood for them, those remaining endured their brothers because of piety, seeing those maltreated being tortured unto death,

Chapter 14

1 further urging them on toward maltreatment, so that they not only despised the pains, but also ruled the passions of brotherly love.

2 O reasons more royal than kings and freer than free men.

3 O sacred and well-harmonized concord of the seven brothers concerning piety.

4 None of the seven youths became cowardly or hesitated before death,

5 but all, as though running onto a road of immortality, hastened toward death through tortures.

6 Just as the hands and feet move in accord with the soul's directions, so those holy youths, as though under the immortal soul of piety, agreed together upon death for it.

7 O most holy seven of brothers in concord. For just as the seven days of the creation of the world around piety,

8 so the youths, dancing around the seven, circled, overthrowing the fear of tortures.

9 Now we shudder on hearing the affliction of those young men; but they, not merely seeing, nor merely hearing the immediate word of threat, but also suffering, persisted, and this in pains through fire;

10 what could be more painful than these? For the force of fire, being sharp and swift, quickly dissolved their bodies.

11 And do not consider it wondrous if reason mastered those men in the tortures, since even a woman's mind despised pains of more varied kinds;

12 for the mother of the seven young men bore the tortures upon each one of her children.

13 And observe how intricate is the affection of love for children, drawing everything toward heartfelt sympathy,

14 since even irrational animals have sympathy and affection toward those born from them similar to humans.

15 For among the birds, the tame ones walking on roofs around the houses defend their nestlings,

16 while the others, having built nests on mountaintops and in the clefts of ravines and the hollows of trees and their summits, lay their young and hinder anyone approaching;

17 and if they cannot hinder them, flying all around them, grieving in their affection and crying out in their own voice, they help their children as they can.

18 And why must one demonstrate sympathy toward children through irrational animals,

19 when even bees, about the time of wax-making, defend themselves against those approaching and strike with their sting, as though with iron, those approaching their nest, and ward them off until death?

20 But sympathy for children did not move the young men's mother, who shared Abraam's soul.

Chapter 15

1 O reason, tyrant over passions concerning children, and piety more desirable to a mother than children.

2 The mother, with two things set before her, piety and the temporary preservation of seven sons according to the tyrant's promise,

3 loved piety more, which saves unto eternal life according to God.

4 O in what manner might I describe parents' passions of love for children? We impress a likeness of both soul and form into the wondrous small image of a child, especially because mothers are more sympathetic than fathers to the sufferings of those born.

5 For insofar as mothers are weaker in soul and more prolific, so much more do they love their children.

6 And the mother of the seven children became more loving of children than all mothers, who, through seven pregnancies, planting further her affection toward them,

7 and compelled through the many birth pains for each one of them to have sympathy toward them,

8 disregarded the temporary preservation of her children because of her fear toward God.

9 Indeed, also because of her sons' nobility and goodness and their obedience toward the law, she had greater affection for them.

10 For they were righteous and temperate and courageous and magnanimous and loving of brothers and loving of their mother, so as to obey her even unto death while keeping the ordinances.

11 But nevertheless, although there were so many things concerning love for children drawing the mother toward sympathy, the tortures of every varied kind were unable to change her reason in the case of any of them,

12 but the mother exhorted both each child and all together toward the death of piety.

13 O sacred nature and parents' affections and affectionate generation and nurture and mothers' untamable passions.

14 Seeing each one racked and burned, the mother did not change because of piety.

15 She saw her children's flesh melting around the fire and the toes and fingers twitching upon the earth and the flesh of their heads as far as the cheeks laid out like masks.

16 O mother, now tried by more bitter pains than the birth pains for them.

17 O woman who alone gave birth to piety in its entirety.

18 Your firstborn breathing his last did not change you, nor the second looking piteously toward you in tortures, nor the third expiring,

19 and seeing the eyes of each one looking like a bull upon the same maltreatment in the tortures, and their nostrils giving signs beforehand of their death, you did not weep.

20 Seeing children's flesh burned away upon children's flesh, and hands cut off upon hands, and heads severed from their necks upon heads, and dead falling upon dead, and seeing the place become a common grave of your children through the tortures, you did not shed tears.

21 Neither sirens' melodies nor swans' voices draw listeners toward delight in hearing as do the voices of children calling their mother amid tortures.

22 With how great and how many tortures was the mother then tortured, while her sons were tortured with wheels and burning irons.

23 But pious reason, making her heart courageous in the very passions, urged her to disregard temporary love for children.

24 Although seeing the destruction of seven children and the intricate variety of racks, the noble mother rendered them all powerless through faith toward God.

25 For, as though in a council chamber, seeing in her own soul dreadful counselors, nature and generation and love for children and the tortures of children,

26 the mother, holding two votes for her children, one death-bearing and one saving,

27 did not choose the preservation that saved seven sons for a little time,

28 but the daughter remembered the God-revering endurance of Abraam.

29 O mother of a nation, vindicator of the law and defender of piety and prize-bearer of the contest through the heart;

30 O nobler than males in steadfastness and more courageous than men in endurance.

31 For just as Noe's ark, bearing the world in the world-filling flood, steadfastly endured the surges,

32 so you, guardian of the law, flooded from every side in the deluge of the passions and beset by strong winds, the tortures of your sons, nobly endured the storms for piety.

Chapter 16

1 If, therefore, even a woman, aged and mother of seven children, endured while seeing her children's tortures unto death, admittedly pious reason is sovereign over the passions.

2 Therefore I demonstrated that not only men ruled the passions, but also a woman despised the greatest tortures.

3 And neither were the lions around Daniel so savage, nor the furnace of Misael blazing with most furious fire, as the nature of love for children burned around her while she saw her seven sons tortured in such varied ways.

4 But by the reason of piety the mother quenched passions so many and so great.

5 For consider this also, that if the woman had been cowardly, although being a mother, she would have lamented over them and perhaps would have said these things:

6 “O miserable me and many times thrice-wretched, who, having borne seven children, have become mother of none.

7 O vain seven pregnancies and profitless seven periods of ten months and fruitless nursing and wretched milk-feeding.

8 And in vain for you, children, I endured many birth pains and the harsher cares of upbringing.

9 O my children, some unmarried, others married without profit; I shall not see your children nor be called grandmother and pronounced blessed.

10 O I, the woman with many children and beautiful children, widowed and alone, full of mourning;

11 nor, if I die, will I have any of my sons to bury me.”

12 But the sacred and God-revering mother lamented for none with this lament, nor turned any of them aside so that they might not die, nor grieved as though they were dying,

13 but, as though having an adamantine mind and giving birth anew to the number of her sons unto immortality, she rather exhorted them toward death for piety, entreating them.

14 O mother, soldier of God through piety, aged woman and wife, through steadfastness you defeated even a tyrant and were found mightier than a man in both deeds and words.

15 For when you were seized with your children, you stood seeing Eleazaros being tortured and said to your children in the Hebrew tongue,

16 “O children, noble is the contest to which you were called for the testimony of the nation; contend eagerly in it for the ancestral law;

17 for it is shameful that this old man should endure the pains because of piety, but you young men be struck with terror by the tortures.

18 Remember that because of God you partook of the world and enjoyed life,

19 and because of this you ought to endure every pain because of God,

20 because of whom our father Abraam also hastened to slaughter his son Isaak, father of the nation, and he, seeing his father's sword-bearing hand descending upon him, did not cower.

21 And righteous Daniel was thrown among lions, and Ananias and Azarias and Misael were hurled into a furnace of fire and endured because of God.

22 Therefore you also, having the same faith toward God, do not be distressed.

23 For it is unreasonable, knowing piety, not to withstand the pains.”

24 Through these words the mother of seven, exhorting each one of her sons, persuaded them to die rather than transgress the commandment of God,

25 and further knowing these things also, that those dying because of God live to God, as do Abraam and Isaak and Iakob and all the patriarchs.

Chapter 17

1 And some of the guards also said that, when she herself was about to be seized for death, so that no one might touch her body, she threw herself onto the pyre.

2 O mother who, with seven children, overthrew the tyrant's force and rendered his evil designs powerless and showed the nobility of faith.

3 For like a roof, you, nobly established upon the pillars of your children, bore without bending the earthquake through the tortures.

4 Take courage, therefore, mother of a sacred soul, having the hope of endurance firm toward God.

5 The moon has not stood so venerable in heaven with stars as you, having guided your seven star-like children with light toward piety, have stood honored by God and have been established with them in heaven;

6 for your childbearing was from Abraam the father.

7 But if it were possible for us to paint the history of your piety as upon something, would not the spectators shudder, seeing a mother of seven children who endured varied tortures unto death because of piety?

8 For it was also worthy to inscribe upon the tomb itself these things also, said for remembrance to those of the nation:

9 “Here an old priest and an aged woman and seven children have been buried through the force of a tyrant wishing to overthrow the citizenship of the Hebrews,

10 who also vindicated the race, looking toward God and enduring the tortures unto death.”

11 For truly divine was the contest that took place through them.

12 For virtue then presided over the contest, testing through endurance. The victory: incorruption in long-lasting life.

13 And Eleazar contended first, and the mother of the seven children competed, and the brothers contended;

14 the tyrant contended against them, while the world and human life watched;

15 and reverence for God was victorious, crowning its own athletes.

16 Who did not admire the athletes of the divine legislation? Who were not astounded?

17 Indeed, the tyrant himself and the whole council admired their endurance,

18 through which they also now stand beside the divine throne and live the blessed age.

19 For Moyses also says, “And all those sanctified under your hands.”

20 And these, therefore, having been sanctified because of God, have been honored, not only with this honor, but also by the fact that through them the enemies did not prevail over our nation,

21 and the tyrant was punished and the homeland purified, as though they had become an exchange of lives for the nation's sin.

22 And through the blood of those pious men and the propitiation of their death, divine providence preserved Israel, who had previously been afflicted.

23 For looking toward their courage in virtue and their endurance in the tortures, the tyrant Antiochos proclaimed their endurance as an example to his soldiers,

24 and he had them noble and courageous for infantry battle and siege, and, having ravaged, defeated all the enemies.

Chapter 18

1 O descendant children of the seeds of Abraam, Israelites, obey this law and practice piety in every manner,

2 knowing that pious reason is master of the passions, and not only of those within, but also of the pains from outside.

3 In return for these things, having surrendered their bodies to pains because of piety, those men were not only admired by humans, but also deemed worthy of a divine portion.

4 And because of them the nation was at peace, and, having renewed observance of law in the homeland, they have ravaged the enemies.

5 And the tyrant Antiochos has been punished on earth also, and, having died, is being chastised; for when he was utterly unable in any way to compel the inhabitants of Ierosolyma to adopt foreign ways and depart from their ancestral customs of living, then, departing from Ierosolyma, he campaigned against the Persians.

6 And the mother of the seven children also said these ordinances to her children:

7 “I became a pure virgin and did not go beyond my father's house, but guarded the built rib.

8 Neither did a ravager of the wilderness, a corrupter in the plain, corrupt me, nor did a ravager of deceit, a serpent, ruin the pure things of my virginity.

9 And I remained with a husband for the time of my prime; but when these had come of age, their father died, blessed indeed was he, for having lived through the life of having good children, he did not suffer the time of childlessness.

10 He taught you the law and the prophets while still being with you.

11 And he read to you of Abel killed by Kain and Isaak being offered as a whole offering and Ioseph in prison.

12 And he told you of the zealous Phinees, and taught you of Ananias and Azarias and Misael in fire.

13 And he also glorified Daniel in the lions' pit, whom he pronounced blessed.

14 And he also reminded you of the writing of Esaias that says, ‘Even if you pass through fire, a flame will not burn you up.’

15 He sang to you the hymn-writer Dauid, saying, ‘Many are the afflictions of the righteous.’

16 He recited proverbs to you from Salomon, saying, ‘It is a tree of life to those who do his will.’

17 He made credible Iezekiel, who says, ‘Will these dry bones live?’

18 For he did not forget to teach the song that Moyses taught, which says,

19 ‘I will kill and make alive; this is your life and the length of your days.’”

20 O bitter day then and not bitter, when the bitter tyrant of the Greeks, quenching fire with fire in cruel cauldrons and with boiling rages, brought the seven children of the woman of Abraam onto the catapult and again to his tortures,

21 maimed the pupils of their eyes and cut out their tongues and killed them with varied tortures.

22 For these things divine justice pursued and will pursue the accursed tyrant.

23 But the children of Abraam, with their prize-bearing mother, gather together into the chorus of the fathers, having received pure and immortal souls from God.

24 To whom be the glory unto the ages of the ages; amen.

Psalms

Chapter 1

1 Blessed is the man who did not walk in the counsel of the impious and did not stand in the way of sinners and did not sit on the seat of pestilent men,

2 but his will is in the law of the Lord, and in his law he will meditate by day and by night.

3 And he will be like the tree planted beside the outlets of the waters, which will give its fruit in its season, and its leaf will not fall off; and everything he does will be prospered.

4 Not so the impious, not so, but like the chaff that the wind casts away from the face of the earth.

5 Because of this the impious will not rise in judgment, nor sinners in the counsel of the righteous;

6 for the Lord knows the way of the righteous, and the way of the impious will perish.

Chapter 2

1 Why did nations rage and peoples meditate on empty things?

2 The kings of the earth stood forth, and the rulers gathered together against the Lord and against his anointed one. Interlude.

3 “Let us tear apart their bonds and cast away their yoke from us.”

4 The one dwelling in the heavens will laugh at them, and the Lord will mock them.

5 Then he will speak to them in his wrath and in his anger will trouble them.

6 “But I was appointed king by him upon Sion, his holy mountain,

7 proclaiming the ordinance of the Lord. The Lord said to me, ‘You are my son; I have begotten you today;

8 ask of me, and I will give you nations as your inheritance and the ends of the earth as your possession;

9 you will shepherd them with an iron rod; like a potter's vessel you will shatter them.’”

10 And now, kings, understand; be instructed, all who judge the earth.

11 Serve the Lord in fear and exult in him with trembling.

12 Take hold of instruction, lest the Lord become angry and you perish from a righteous way. When his anger is quickly kindled, blessed are all who have trusted in him.

Chapter 3

1 A psalm for Dauid, when he was fleeing from the presence of Abessalom his son.

2 Lord, why have those afflicting me multiplied? Many rise up against me;

3 many say to my soul, “There is no salvation for him in his God.” Interlude.

4 But you, Lord, are my helper, my glory and the one lifting up my head.

5 With my voice I cried to the Lord, and he heard me from his holy mountain. Interlude.

6 I lay down and slept; I awoke, for the Lord will help me.

7 I will not fear myriads of people who together attack me all around.

8 Rise, Lord; save me, my God, for you struck all those who are my enemies without cause; you shattered sinners' teeth.

9 Salvation belongs to the Lord, and your blessing is upon your people.

Chapter 4

1 For the end, in psalms; a song for Dauid.

2 When I called, the God of my righteousness heard me; in affliction you made room for me; have compassion on me and hear my prayer.

3 Sons of humans, how long will you be heavy-hearted? Why do you love vanity and seek falsehood? Interlude.

4 And know that the Lord made his holy one wondrous; the Lord will hear me when I cry to him.

5 Be angry and do not sin; speak in your hearts and upon your beds be pierced with remorse. Interlude.

6 Sacrifice a sacrifice of righteousness and hope in the Lord.

7 Many say, “Who will show us good things?” The light of your face was marked upon us, Lord.

8 You gave gladness into my heart; from the season of their grain and wine and oil they were multiplied.

9 In peace I will both lie down and sleep, for you, Lord, alone made me dwell in hope.

Chapter 5

1 For the end, concerning her who inherits; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Give ear to my words, Lord; understand my cry;

3 attend to the voice of my petition, my king and my God. For to you I will pray, Lord;

4 in the morning you will hear my voice; in the morning I will stand before you and watch.

5 For you are not a God willing lawlessness, nor will one doing evil sojourn with you;

6 lawless men will not remain before your eyes; you hated all who work lawlessness.

7 You will destroy all who speak falsehood; the Lord abhors a man of bloodshed and deceit.

8 But I, in the abundance of your mercy, will enter your house; I will bow toward your holy temple in fear of you.

9 Lord, guide me in your righteousness because of my enemies; make your way straight before me.

10 For there is no truth in their mouth; their heart is vain; their throat is an opened grave; with their tongues they practiced deceit.

11 Judge them, God; let them fall away from their counsels; according to the abundance of their impieties cast them out, for they embittered you, Lord.

12 And let all who hope in you be glad; they will exult forever, and you will dwell among them, and all who love your name will boast in you.

13 For you will bless a righteous man; Lord, as with a shield of favor you crowned us.

Chapter 6

1 For the end, in hymns, concerning the eighth; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Lord, do not rebuke me in your anger nor instruct me in your wrath.

3 Have mercy on me, Lord, for I am weak; heal me, Lord, for my bones were troubled,

4 and my soul was exceedingly troubled; and you, Lord, how long?

5 Return, Lord; rescue my soul; save me for the sake of your mercy.

6 For in death there is no one remembering you; and in Hades who will give thanks to you?

7 I grew weary in my groaning; every night I will wash my bed; with my tears I will wet my bedding.

8 My eye was troubled from anger; I grew old among all my enemies.

9 Depart from me, all who work lawlessness, for the Lord heard the voice of my weeping;

10 the Lord heard my petition; the Lord accepted my prayer.

11 May all my enemies be ashamed and exceedingly troubled; may they turn back and be exceedingly put to shame swiftly.

Chapter 7

1 A psalm for Dauid, which he sang to the Lord concerning the words of Chousi son of Iemeni.

2 Lord my God, in you I hoped; save me from all who pursue me and rescue me,

3 lest he seize my soul like a lion, with no one redeeming or saving.

4 Lord my God, if I did this, if there is injustice in my hands,

5 if I repaid evil to those repaying me, then may I fall away empty from my enemies,

6 then may the enemy pursue my soul and overtake it and trample my life into the earth and make my glory dwell in dust. Interlude.

7 Rise, Lord, in your wrath; be exalted at the boundaries of my enemies; awake, Lord my God, in the ordinance that you commanded,

8 and a gathering of peoples will surround you, and for its sake return on high.

9 The Lord will judge peoples; judge me, Lord, according to my righteousness and according to my innocence upon me.

10 Let the wickedness of sinners now come to an end, and you will direct a righteous man; God examines hearts and kidneys.

11 My help is righteous, from God who saves the upright in heart.

12 God is a righteous judge and strong and long-suffering, not bringing wrath every day.

13 If you do not turn back, he will polish his sword; he drew his bow and prepared it,

14 and on it he prepared instruments of death; he fashioned his arrows for those being burned.

15 Look, he labored with injustice, conceived trouble and gave birth to lawlessness;

16 he dug a pit and excavated it and will fall into the hole that he made;

17 his trouble will return upon his head, and his injustice will descend upon his crown.

18 I will give thanks to the Lord according to his righteousness and sing to the name of the Lord Most High.

Chapter 8

1 For the end, concerning the winepresses; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Lord our Lord, how wondrous is your name in all the earth, for your magnificence was lifted above the heavens.

3 From the mouth of infants and nursing children you established praise because of your enemies, to overthrow an enemy and an avenger.

4 For I will see the heavens, works of your fingers, the moon and stars, which you founded.

5 What is a human that you remember him, or a son of a human that you visit him?

6 You made him a little less than angels; with glory and honor you crowned him;

7 and you appointed him over the works of your hands; you subjected everything beneath his feet,

8 sheep and all oxen, and also the beasts of the plain,

9 the birds of heaven and the fish of the sea, the things passing along paths of seas.

10 Lord our Lord, how wondrous is your name in all the earth.

Chapter 9

1 For the end, concerning the hidden things of the son; a psalm for Dauid.

2 I will give thanks to you, Lord, with my whole heart; I will recount all your wonders;

3 I will be glad and exult in you; I will sing to your name, Most High.

4 When my enemy turns backward, they will weaken and perish from your presence,

5 for you carried out my judgment and my cause; you sat upon a throne, judging righteousness.

6 You rebuked nations, and the impious one perished; you erased their name forever and for the age of the age;

7 the enemy's swords failed completely, and you pulled down cities; their remembrance perished with a sound.

8 And the Lord remains forever; he prepared his throne in judgment,

9 and he himself will judge the inhabited world in righteousness; he will judge peoples in uprightness.

10 And the Lord became a refuge for the needy, a helper at opportune times in affliction;

11 and let those knowing your name hope in you, for you did not abandon those seeking you, Lord.

12 Sing to the Lord who dwells in Sion; proclaim his practices among the nations,

13 for, seeking out bloodshed, he remembered them; he did not forget the cry of the needy.

14 Have mercy on me, Lord; see my humiliation from my enemies, you who lift me from the gates of death,

15 so that I may proclaim all your praises in the gates of the daughter of Sion; I will exult in your salvation.

16 Nations were caught in the destruction that they made; in this trap that they hid their foot was seized;

17 the Lord is known by executing judgments; in the works of his hands the sinner was seized. A song of interlude.

18 Let sinners turn back into Hades, all the nations forgetting God;

19 for the poor will not be forgotten completely; the endurance of the needy will not perish forever.

20 Rise, Lord; let a human not grow strong; let nations be judged before you;

21 appoint, Lord, a lawgiver over them; let nations know that they are humans. Interlude.

22 Why, Lord, have you stood far away, overlooking at opportune times in affliction?

23 When the impious one acts arrogantly, the poor one is set on fire; they are caught in the counsels that they devise.

24 For the sinner is praised in the desires of his soul, and the one doing injustice is blessed;

25 the sinner provoked the Lord: “According to the abundance of his wrath he will not seek out”; God is not before him.

26 His ways are profaned at every time; your judgments are removed from his presence; he will lord it over all his enemies;

27 for he said in his heart, “I will certainly not be shaken, from generation to generation without evil.”

28 His mouth is full of a curse and bitterness and deceit; under his tongue are toil and trouble.

29 He sits in ambush with rich men, in hidden places to kill an innocent man; his eyes look toward the needy;

30 he lies in ambush in a hidden place like a lion in his enclosure; he lies in ambush to seize a poor man, to seize a poor man by dragging him;

31 in his trap he will humble him; he will stoop and fall when he lords it over the needy.

32 For he said in his heart, “God has forgotten; he turned away his face so as not to see at all.”

33 Rise, Lord God; let your hand be lifted up; do not forget the needy;

34 for what reason did the impious one provoke God? For he said in his heart, “He will not seek out.”

35 You see, for you observe trouble and anger, to deliver them into your hands; to you, therefore, the poor one has been left; you were helping the orphan.

36 Shatter the arm of the sinful and wicked one; his sin will be sought, and he will certainly not be found because of it;

37 the Lord will reign forever and for the age of the age; you will perish, nations, from his earth.

38 The Lord heard the desire of the needy; your ear attended to the preparation of their heart,

39 to judge for the orphan and the lowly, so that a human upon the earth may no longer continue boasting greatly.

Chapter 10

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid. In the Lord I have trusted; everyone, will you say to my soul, “Migrate to the mountains like a little bird”?

2 For look, sinners drew a bow; they prepared arrows for a quiver, to shoot in the dark moon at the upright in heart.

3 For what you established they pulled down; but what did the righteous one do?

4 The Lord is in his holy temple; the Lord, his throne is in heaven. His eyes look toward the needy; his eyelids examine the sons of humans.

5 The Lord examines the righteous and the impious, but the one loving injustice hates his own soul.

6 He will rain traps upon sinners; fire and sulfur and a storm wind are the portion of their cup.

7 For the Lord is righteous and loved righteous deeds; his face saw uprightness.

Chapter 11

1 For the end, concerning the eighth; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Save me, Lord, for a holy one has failed, for truths have diminished among the sons of humans.

3 Each spoke vain things to his neighbor; deceitful lips spoke with a heart and with a heart.

4 May the Lord destroy all deceitful lips and a boastful tongue,

5 those who said, “We magnify our tongue; our lips are from us; who is our lord?”

6 “Because of the misery of the poor and because of the groaning of the needy, now I will rise,” says the Lord; “I will place in salvation; I will speak openly in it.”

7 The sayings of the Lord are pure sayings, silver tried by fire, tested for the earth, purified sevenfold.

8 You, Lord, will guard us and preserve us from this generation and forever.

9 The impious walk all around; according to your height you cared greatly for the sons of humans.

Chapter 12

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 How long, Lord, will you forget me completely? How long will you turn your face away from me?

3 Until when will I set counsels in my soul, pains in my heart by day? How long will my enemy be exalted over me?

4 Look upon me; hear me, Lord my God; enlighten my eyes, lest I sleep unto death,

5 lest my enemy say, “I prevailed against him”; those afflicting me will exult if I am shaken.

6 But I hoped in your mercy; my heart will exult in your salvation; I will sing to the Lord who benefited me and sing to the name of the Lord Most High.

Chapter 13

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid. A fool said in his heart, “There is no God”; they corrupted and became abominable in their practices; there is no one doing goodness, there is not even one.

2 The Lord looked down from heaven upon the sons of humans to see whether there is one understanding or seeking God.

3 All turned aside; together they became worthless; there is no one doing goodness, there is not even one. [Their throat is an opened grave; with their tongues they practiced deceit; the venom of asps is under their lips, whose mouth is full of a curse and bitterness; their feet are swift to shed blood; destruction and misery are in their ways, and they did not know a way of peace; there is no fear of God before their eyes.]

4 Will not all who work lawlessness know? Those devouring my people as a meal of bread did not call upon the Lord.

5 There they became cowardly with fear where there was no fear, for God is in a righteous generation.

6 You put a poor man's counsel to shame, for the Lord is his hope.

7 Who will give the salvation of Israel from Sion? When the Lord returns the captivity of his people, let Iakob exult and let Israel be glad.

Chapter 14

1 A psalm for Dauid. Lord, who will sojourn in your dwelling, and who will dwell on your holy mountain?

2 One walking blamelessly and working righteousness, speaking truth in his heart,

3 who did not practice deceit with his tongue nor do evil to his neighbor and did not take up reproach against those nearest him;

4 one doing evil is despised before him, but he glorifies those fearing the Lord; one swearing to his neighbor and not setting it aside;

5 he did not give his silver at interest and did not take gifts against innocent people. One doing these things will not be shaken forever.

Chapter 15

1 An inscription on a pillar for Dauid. Guard me, Lord, for in you I hoped.

2 I said to the Lord, “You are my Lord, for you have no need of my good things.”

3 For the holy ones in his earth he made all his wishes wondrous among them.

4 Their weaknesses were multiplied; after these things they hastened; I will certainly not gather their gatherings from bloodshed, nor will I remember their names through my lips.

5 The Lord is the portion of my inheritance and of my cup; you are the one restoring my inheritance to me.

6 Measuring cords fell to me among the best things; for indeed my inheritance is best for me.

7 I will bless the Lord who gave me understanding; moreover, even until night my kidneys instructed me.

8 I kept seeing the Lord before me continually, for he is at my right, so that I may not be shaken.

9 Because of this my heart was glad and my tongue exulted; moreover, my flesh also will dwell in hope,

10 for you will not abandon my soul to Hades nor allow your holy one to see corruption.

11 You made known to me ways of life; you will fill me with gladness with your presence; delights are in your right hand to the end.

Chapter 16

1 A prayer of Dauid. Hear my righteousness, Lord; attend to my petition; give ear to my prayer, not with deceitful lips.

2 May my judgment come out from your presence; let my eyes see upright things.

3 You tested my heart; you visited by night; you tried me by fire, and injustice was not found in me.

4 So that my mouth might not speak the works of humans, because of the words of your lips I guarded hard ways.

5 Establish my steps in your paths, so that my steps may not be shaken.

6 I cried, for you heard me, God; incline your ear to me and hear my words.

7 Make your mercies wondrous, you who save those hoping in you from those resisting your right hand.

8 Guard me like the pupil of an eye; in the shelter of your wings you will shelter me

9 from the presence of the impious who made me miserable. My enemies surrounded my soul;

10 they enclosed their fat; their mouth spoke arrogance.

11 Casting me out, now they surrounded me; they set their eyes to turn aside upon the earth.

12 They took me like a lion ready for prey and like a young lion dwelling in hidden places.

13 Rise, Lord; get ahead of them and trip them up; rescue my soul from an impious man, your sword from the enemies of your hand.

14 Lord, separate them from a few, from the earth, in their life. And their belly was filled with your hidden things; they were satisfied with sons and left the remnants to their infants.

15 But I will appear before your face in righteousness; I will be satisfied when your glory appears.

Chapter 17

1 For the end; for the Lord's servant Dauid, the words of this song that he spoke to the Lord on the day when the Lord rescued him from the hand of all his enemies and from the hand of Saoul,

2 and he said, “I will love you, Lord my strength.”

3 The Lord is my firmness and my refuge and my rescuer; my God is my helper, and I will hope in him, my defender and the horn of my salvation, my helper.

4 Praising, I will call upon the Lord, and I will be saved from my enemies.

5 Birth pains of death surrounded me, and torrents of lawlessness greatly troubled me;

6 birth pains of Hades encircled me; traps of death got ahead of me.

7 And when I was afflicted I called upon the Lord and cried to my God; he heard my voice from his holy temple, and my cry before him will enter his ears.

8 And the earth was shaken and became trembling, and the foundations of the mountains were troubled and shaken, for God became angry with them.

9 Smoke went up in his wrath, and fire from his presence burned fiercely; coals were kindled from him.

10 And he bent heaven and descended, and darkness was under his feet.

11 And he mounted upon cheroubin and flew; he flew upon wings of winds.

12 And he made darkness his hiding place; his tent was around him, dark water in clouds of the air.

13 From the radiance before him the clouds passed, hail and coals of fire.

14 And the Lord thundered from heaven, and the Most High gave his voice;

15 and he sent out arrows and scattered them, and multiplied lightning flashes and threw them into confusion.

16 And the springs of the waters appeared, and the foundations of the inhabited world were uncovered at your rebuke, Lord, at the blowing of the breath of your wrath.

17 He sent out from on high and took me; he took me to himself out of many waters.

18 He will rescue me from my mighty enemies and from those hating me, for they became stronger than I.

19 They got ahead of me on the day of my affliction, and the Lord became my support

20 and brought me out into a broad place; he will rescue me, for he wanted me. [He will rescue me from my mighty enemies and from those hating me.]

21 And the Lord will repay me according to my righteousness, and according to the cleanness of my hands he will repay me,

22 for I guarded the ways of the Lord and did not act impiously away from my God,

23 for all his judgments are before me, and I did not put his ordinances away from me.

24 And I will be blameless with him and guard myself from my lawlessness.

25 And the Lord will repay me according to my righteousness and according to the cleanness of my hands before his eyes.

26 With a holy one you will act holily, and with an innocent man you will be innocent,

27 and with a chosen one you will be chosen, and with a crooked one you will act crookedly.

28 For you will save a lowly people and humble the eyes of the arrogant.

29 For you will light my lamp, Lord; my God, you will enlighten my darkness.

30 For in you I will be rescued from a band of raiders, and in my God I will pass over a wall.

31 My God, his way is blameless; the sayings of the Lord are tried by fire; he is defender of all who hope in him.

32 For who is God except the Lord? And who is God except our God?

33 God is the one girding me with power, and he made my way blameless,

34 the one establishing my feet like a deer's and setting me upon the heights,

35 teaching my hands for war; and you made my arms a bronze bow;

36 and you gave me the defense of my salvation, and your right hand helped me, and your instruction set me upright completely, and your instruction itself will teach me.

37 You broadened my steps beneath me, and my footprints did not weaken.

38 I will pursue my enemies and overtake them and will not turn back until they fail;

39 I will crush them, and they will certainly not be able to stand; they will fall under my feet.

40 And you girded me with power for war; you fettered all who rose against me beneath me,

41 and you gave me my enemies' back and destroyed those hating me.

42 They cried, and there was no one saving; to the Lord, and he did not hear them.

43 And I will grind them fine like dust before the wind; like mud of streets I will smooth them down.

44 You will rescue me from the contradictions of a people; you will appoint me head of nations; a people whom I did not know served me,

45 at the hearing of an ear it obeyed me; foreign sons lied to me,

46 foreign sons grew old and limped away from their paths.

47 The Lord lives, and blessed is my God, and let the God of my salvation be exalted,

48 God who gives me acts of vengeance and subjected peoples beneath me,

49 my rescuer from my angry enemies; you will exalt me above those rising against me; you will rescue me from an unjust man.

50 Because of this I will give thanks to you among nations, Lord, and sing to your name,

51 he who magnifies the salvations of his king and does mercy to his anointed one, to Dauid and to his seed forever.

Chapter 18

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 The heavens recount God's glory, and the firmament proclaims the making of his hands;

3 day pours forth a word to day, and night proclaims knowledge to night.

4 There are no speeches nor words whose voices are not heard;

5 their sound went out into all the earth, and their words to the ends of the inhabited world. In the sun he set his dwelling;

6 and he himself, like a bridegroom coming out of his bridal chamber, will exult like a giant to run his way.

7 His departure is from the end of heaven, and his arrival as far as the end of heaven, and there is no one who will be hidden from his heat.

8 The law of the Lord is blameless, turning souls back; the testimony of the Lord is faithful, making infants wise;

9 the ordinances of the Lord are upright, gladdening a heart; the commandment of the Lord is radiant, enlightening eyes;

10 the fear of the Lord is pure, remaining for the age of the age; the judgments of the Lord are true, justified together,

11 desirable beyond gold and much precious stone, and sweeter than honey and honeycomb.

12 For indeed your servant guards them; in guarding them there is much repayment.

13 Who will understand trespasses? Cleanse me from my hidden things.

14 And spare your servant from foreign ones; if they do not lord it over me, then I will be blameless and will be cleansed from great sin.

15 And the sayings of my mouth and the meditation of my heart will be for acceptance before you continually, Lord, my helper and my redeemer.

Chapter 19

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 May the Lord hear you in a day of affliction; may the name of the God of Iakob defend you.

3 May he send help to you from the holy place and help you from Sion.

4 May he remember all your sacrifice, and let him make your whole burnt offering fat. Interlude.

5 May he give you according to your heart and fulfill all your counsel.

6 We will exult in your salvation and be magnified in the name of our God. May the Lord fulfill all your requests.

7 Now I knew that the Lord saved his anointed one; he will hear him from his holy heaven; the salvation of his right hand is in mighty acts.

8 These in chariots and these in horses, but we will be magnified in the name of the Lord our God.

9 They were fettered together and fell, but we rose and were set upright.

10 Lord, save your king and hear us on whatever day we call upon you.

Chapter 20

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Lord, in your power the king will be glad and in your salvation he will exult exceedingly.

3 You gave him the desire of his soul and did not deprive him of the wish of his lips. Interlude.

4 For you went before him with blessings of goodness; you placed a crown of precious stone upon his head.

5 He asked you for life, and you gave it to him, length of days for the age of the age.

6 Great is his glory in your salvation; you will place glory and magnificence upon him;

7 for you will give him blessing for the age of the age; you will gladden him with joy in your presence.

8 For the king hopes in the Lord, and in the mercy of the Most High he will certainly not be shaken.

9 May your hand be found by all your enemies; may your right hand find all who hate you.

10 You will make them like an oven of fire at the time of your presence; the Lord in his wrath will throw them into confusion, and fire will devour them.

11 You will destroy their fruit from the earth and their seed from the sons of humans,

12 for they inclined evils against you; they devised a counsel that they will certainly not be able to establish.

13 For you will make them turn their back; among your remnants you will prepare their face.

14 Be exalted, Lord, in your power; we will sing and make music of your mighty acts.

Chapter 21

1 For the end, concerning the morning help; a psalm for Dauid.

2 God, my God, attend to me; why did you abandon me? Far from my salvation are the words of my trespasses.

3 My God, I will cry by day, and you will not hear, and by night, and it is not unto folly for me.

4 But you dwell among holy ones, the praise of Israel.

5 In you our fathers hoped; they hoped, and you rescued them;

6 to you they cried and were saved; in you they hoped and were not put to shame.

7 But I am a worm and not a human, a reproach of a human and a despised thing of a people.

8 All who see me mocked me; they spoke with lips, they moved their head:

9 “He hoped in the Lord; let him rescue him; let him save him, for he wants him.”

10 For you are the one who drew me from the belly, my hope from my mother's breasts;

11 upon you I was cast from the womb; from my mother's belly you are my God.

12 Do not depart from me, for affliction is near, for there is no one helping.

13 Many calves encircled me; fat bulls surrounded me;

14 they opened their mouth against me like a lion seizing and roaring.

15 Like water I was poured out, and all my bones were scattered; my heart became like wax melting in the midst of my belly;

16 my strength dried up like a potsherd, and my tongue has stuck to my throat, and you brought me down into dust of death.

17 For many dogs surrounded me; a gathering of evildoers surrounded me; they dug through my hands and feet.

18 I counted all my bones, but they observed and looked upon me.

19 They divided my garments among themselves and cast a lot for my clothing.

20 But you, Lord, do not put my help far away; attend to my assistance.

21 Rescue my soul from a sword and my only one from the hand of a dog;

22 save me from a lion's mouth, and my humiliation from the horns of one-horned beasts.

23 I will recount your name to my brothers; in the midst of an assembly I will hymn you:

24 “You who fear the Lord, praise him; all the seed of Iakob, glorify him; let all the seed of Israel fear him,

25 for he did not despise nor become vexed at the petition of the poor, nor turn his face away from me, and when I cried to him he heard me.”

26 My praise is from you in a great assembly; I will pay my vows before those fearing him.

27 The needy will eat and be filled, and those seeking him will praise the Lord; their hearts will live for the age of the age.

28 All the ends of the earth will remember and turn back to the Lord, and all the families of the nations will bow before you,

29 for the kingdom belongs to the Lord, and he rules the nations.

30 All the fat ones of the earth ate and bowed; all those descending into the earth will fall before him. And my soul lives to him,

31 and my seed will serve him; the coming generation will be proclaimed to the Lord,

32 and they will proclaim his righteousness to a people who will be born, for the Lord did it.

Chapter 22

1 A psalm for Dauid. The Lord shepherds me, and nothing will be lacking to me.

2 In a place of green grass, there he made me dwell; at water of rest he nourished me;

3 he turned my soul back. He guided me upon paths of righteousness for the sake of his name.

4 For even if I walk in the midst of a shadow of death, I will not fear evils, for you are with me; your rod and your staff, these comforted me.

5 You prepared a table before me opposite those afflicting me; you enriched my head with oil, and your cup intoxicates like the best.

6 And your mercy will pursue me all the days of my life, and my dwelling in the Lord's house will be for length of days.

Chapter 23

1 A psalm for Dauid; of the first day of the week. The earth belongs to the Lord and its fullness, the inhabited world and all who dwell in it;

2 he founded it upon seas and prepared it upon rivers.

3 Who will ascend to the mountain of the Lord, and who will stand in his holy place?

4 One innocent in hands and pure in heart, who did not take his soul for vanity and did not swear deceitfully to his neighbor.

5 This one will receive blessing from the Lord and mercy from God his savior.

6 This is the generation of those seeking him, seeking the face of the God of Iakob. Interlude.

7 Raise gates, your rulers, and be lifted up, eternal gates, and the king of glory will enter.

8 Who is this king of glory? The Lord strong and mighty, the Lord mighty in war.

9 Raise gates, your rulers, and be lifted up, eternal gates, and the king of glory will enter.

10 Who is this king of glory? The Lord of powers, he is the king of glory.

Chapter 24

1 A psalm for Dauid. To you, Lord, I lifted my soul, my God.

2 In you I have trusted; may I not be put to shame, nor let my enemies laugh at me.

3 For indeed all who wait for you will certainly not be put to shame; let all who act lawlessly without cause be ashamed.

4 Make your ways known to me, Lord, and teach me your paths.

5 Guide me into your truth and teach me, for you are God my savior, and I waited for you the whole day.

6 Remember your compassions, Lord, and your mercies, for they are from eternity.

7 Do not remember the sins of my youth and my ignorance; according to your mercy remember me yourself, for the sake of your goodness, Lord.

8 Good and upright is the Lord; because of this he will instruct sinners in the way.

9 He will guide the meek in judgment; he will teach the meek his ways.

10 All the Lord's ways are mercy and truth for those seeking his covenant and his testimonies.

11 For the sake of your name, Lord, you will also be gracious toward my sin, for it is great.

12 Who is the human fearing the Lord? He will instruct him in the way that he chose.

13 His soul will lodge among good things, and his seed will inherit earth.

14 The Lord is the strength of those fearing him, [and the name of the Lord belongs to those fearing him,] and his covenant is to make it plain to them.

15 My eyes are continually toward the Lord, for he himself will draw my feet out of a trap.

16 Look upon me and have mercy on me, for I am alone and poor.

17 The afflictions of my heart were broadened; bring me out of my necessities.

18 See my humiliation and my toil and forgive all my sins.

19 See my enemies, for they multiplied and hated me with unjust hatred.

20 Guard my soul and rescue me; may I not be put to shame, for I hoped in you.

21 Innocent and upright men clung to me, for I waited for you, Lord.

22 Redeem Israel, God, from all his afflictions.

Chapter 25

1 Of Dauid. Judge me, Lord, for I walked in my innocence, and hoping in the Lord I will certainly not weaken.

2 Test me, Lord, and try me; try my kidneys and my heart by fire.

3 For your mercy is before my eyes, and I was well pleasing in your truth.

4 I did not sit with a council of vanity, and I will certainly not enter with those transgressing the law;

5 I hated an assembly of evildoers, and I will certainly not sit with the impious.

6 I will wash my hands among innocent people and circle your altar, Lord,

7 to hear a voice of praise and recount all your wonders.

8 Lord, I loved the beauty of your house and the place of the dwelling of your glory.

9 Do not destroy my soul together with the impious, nor my life with men of bloodshed,

10 in whose hands are lawless deeds; their right hand was filled with gifts.

11 But I walked in my innocence; redeem me and have mercy on me.

12 For my foot stood in uprightness; in assemblies I will bless you, Lord.

Chapter 26

1 Of Dauid; before being anointed. The Lord is my enlightenment and my savior; whom will I fear? The Lord is defender of my life; of whom will I be afraid?

2 When evildoers drew near against me to eat my flesh, those afflicting me and my enemies themselves weakened and fell;

3 if an encampment arrays itself against me, my heart will not fear; if war rises against me, in this I hope.

4 One thing I asked from the Lord, this I will seek: that I dwell in the Lord's house all the days of my life, that I see the delight of the Lord and visit his temple.

5 For he hid me in a tent on a day of my evils; he sheltered me in the hidden place of his tent; on a rock he exalted me;

6 and now look, he lifted my head over my enemies; I circled and sacrificed a sacrifice of shouting in his tent; I will sing and make music to the Lord.

7 Hear, Lord, my voice with which I cried; have mercy on me and hear me.

8 My heart said to you, “It sought my face”; your face, Lord, I will seek.

9 Do not turn your face away from me; do not turn aside in wrath from your servant; become my helper; do not spurn me and do not abandon me, God my savior.

10 For my father and my mother abandoned me, but the Lord took me to himself.

11 Instruct me, Lord, in your way and guide me in a straight path because of my enemies.

12 Do not deliver me into the souls of those afflicting me, for unjust witnesses rose against me, and injustice lied to itself.

13 I believe that I will see the good things of the Lord in the land of the living.

14 Wait for the Lord; be courageous, and let your heart grow strong, and wait for the Lord.

Chapter 27

1 Of Dauid. To you, Lord, I cried, my God; do not keep silence toward me, lest you keep silence toward me and I become like those descending into a pit.

2 Hear the voice of my petition when I petition you, when I lift my hands toward your holy temple.

3 Do not drag my soul away with sinners, and do not destroy me together with those working injustice, who speak peace with their neighbors but have evils in their hearts.

4 Give them according to their works and according to the wickedness of their practices; according to the works of their hands give them; repay their repayment to them.

5 For they did not understand the works of the Lord and the works of his hands; you will pull them down and will certainly not build them up.

6 Blessed is the Lord, for he heard the voice of my petition.

7 The Lord is my helper and my defender; my heart hoped in him, and I was helped, and my flesh flourished anew; and from my will I will give thanks to him.

8 The Lord is the strength of his people and defender of the salvations of his anointed one.

9 Save your people and bless your inheritance and shepherd them and lift them up forever.

Chapter 28

1 A psalm for Dauid; of the departure of the tent. Bring to the Lord, sons of God; bring to the Lord sons of rams; bring to the Lord glory and honor,

2 bring to the Lord glory for his name; bow to the Lord in his holy court.

3 The Lord's voice is over the waters; the God of glory thundered; the Lord is over many waters.

4 The Lord's voice is in strength; the Lord's voice is in magnificence.

5 The voice of the Lord who shatters cedars; and the Lord will shatter the cedars of Libanos

6 and grind them fine like the calf, Libanos, and the beloved one like a son of one-horned beasts.

7 The voice of the Lord who cuts through a flame of fire,

8 the voice of the Lord who shakes a wilderness; and the Lord will shake the wilderness of Kades.

9 The voice of the Lord who establishes deer; and he will uncover forests; and in his temple everyone speaks glory.

10 The Lord will settle the flood, and the Lord sits as king forever.

11 The Lord will give strength to his people; the Lord will bless his people in peace.

Chapter 29

1 For the end; a psalm of a song of the dedication of the house; for Dauid.

2 I will exalt you, Lord, for you took me up and did not gladden my enemies over me.

3 Lord my God, I cried to you, and you healed me;

4 Lord, you brought my soul up from Hades; you saved me from those descending into a pit.

5 Sing to the Lord, his holy ones, and give thanks at the remembrance of his holiness;

6 for wrath is in his anger, and life in his will; weeping will lodge in the evening, and exultation in the morning.

7 But I said in my prosperity, “I will certainly not be shaken forever.”

8 Lord, in your will you provided strength for my beauty; but you turned away your face, and I became troubled.

9 To you, Lord, I will cry, and to my God I will petition:

10 “What profit is there in my blood, in my descending into corruption? Will dust give thanks to you or proclaim your truth?”

11 The Lord heard and had mercy on me; the Lord became my helper.

12 You turned my mourning into dancing for me; you tore apart my sackcloth and girded me with gladness,

13 so that my glory may sing to you and I may certainly not be pierced with grief; Lord my God, forever I will give thanks to you.

Chapter 30

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid; of bewilderment.

2 In you, Lord, I hoped; may I not be put to shame forever; in your righteousness rescue me and deliver me.

3 Incline your ear toward me; hasten to deliver me; become for me a defending God and a house of refuge to save me.

4 For you are my strength and my refuge, and for the sake of your name you will guide me and nourish me;

5 you will bring me out of this trap that they hid for me, for you are my defender.

6 Into your hands I will entrust my spirit; you redeemed me, Lord, God of truth.

7 You hated those guarding vanities in vain; but I hoped in the Lord.

8 I will exult and be glad in your mercy, for you looked upon my humiliation; you saved my soul from necessities

9 and did not enclose me in an enemy's hands; you set my feet in a spacious place.

10 Have mercy on me, Lord, for I am afflicted; my eye was troubled in anger, my soul and my belly.

11 For my life failed in pain and my years in groanings; my strength weakened in poverty, and my bones were troubled.

12 Among all my enemies I became a reproach, and exceedingly to my neighbors, and a fear to my acquaintances; those seeing me outside fled from me.

13 I was forgotten from the heart like a dead man; I became like a lost vessel.

14 For I heard the reproach of many dwelling all around; when they gathered together against me, they counseled to take my soul.

15 But I hoped in you, Lord; I said, “You are my God.”

16 My times are in your hands; rescue me from the hand of my enemies and from those pursuing me.

17 Make your face shine upon your servant; save me in your mercy.

18 Lord, may I not be put to shame, for I called upon you; may the impious be ashamed and brought down into Hades.

19 Let deceitful lips become speechless, those speaking lawlessness against the righteous in arrogance and contempt.

20 How great is the abundance of your goodness, Lord, which you hid for those fearing you, which you worked for those hoping in you before the sons of humans.

21 You will hide them in the hidden place of your presence from the turmoil of humans; you will shelter them in a tent from the contradiction of tongues.

22 Blessed is the Lord, for he made his mercy wondrous in a city under siege.

23 But I said in my bewilderment, “Then I have been cast away from before your eyes.” Because of this you heard the voice of my petition when I cried to you.

24 Love the Lord, all his holy ones, for the Lord seeks truths and repays those acting with excessive arrogance.

25 Be courageous, and let your heart grow strong, all who hope in the Lord.

Chapter 31

1 For Dauid; of understanding. Blessed are those whose lawless deeds were forgiven and whose sins were covered;

2 blessed is the man whose sin the Lord will certainly not reckon, nor is there deceit in his mouth.

3 For I kept silence; my bones grew old from my crying the whole day;

4 for by day and by night your hand weighed heavily upon me; I was turned into misery when a thorn was fixed in me. Interlude.

5 I made my sin known and did not cover my lawlessness; I said, “I will declare against myself my lawlessness to the Lord”; and you forgave the impiety of my sin. Interlude.

6 For this every holy one will pray to you at a suitable time; surely in a flood of many waters they will not draw near him.

7 You are my refuge from the affliction surrounding me; my exultation, redeem me from those encircling me. Interlude.

8 I will give you understanding and instruct you in this way that you will walk; I will fix my eyes upon you.

9 Do not become like a horse and mule, in whom there is no understanding; with bridle and muzzle tighten their jaws, of those not drawing near you.

10 Many are the scourges of the sinner, but mercy will surround the one hoping in the Lord.

11 Be glad in the Lord and exult, righteous ones, and boast, all the upright in heart.

Chapter 32

1 For Dauid. Exult, righteous ones, in the Lord; praise befits the upright.

2 Give thanks to the Lord with a lyre; with a ten-stringed psaltery sing to him.

3 Sing him a new song; make music well with shouting.

4 For the word of the Lord is upright, and all his works are in faithfulness;

5 he loves mercy and judgment; the earth is full of the Lord's mercy.

6 By the Lord's word the heavens were established, and by the breath of his mouth all their host;

7 he gathers the sea's waters like a wineskin, placing abysses in treasuries.

8 Let all the earth fear the Lord, and let all who inhabit the inhabited world be shaken before him;

9 for he himself spoke, and they came to be; he himself commanded, and they were created.

10 The Lord scatters nations' counsels, and sets aside peoples' reasonings and sets aside rulers' counsels;

11 but the Lord's counsel remains forever, the reasonings of his heart from generation to generation.

12 Blessed is the nation whose God is the Lord, the people whom he chose as an inheritance for himself.

13 From heaven the Lord looked down; he saw all the sons of humans;

14 from his prepared dwelling he looked upon all who inhabit the earth,

15 he who formed their hearts individually, who understands all their works.

16 A king is not saved through a great host, and a giant will not be saved by the abundance of his strength;

17 a horse is false for salvation, and in the abundance of its power it will not be saved.

18 Look, the Lord's eyes are upon those fearing him, those hoping in his mercy,

19 to rescue their souls from death and nourish them in famine.

20 Our soul waits for the Lord, for he is our helper and defender;

21 for in him our heart will be glad, and in his holy name we hoped.

22 May your mercy, Lord, be upon us, just as we hoped in you.

Chapter 33

1 For Dauid, when he altered his face before Abimelech, and he released him, and he departed.

2 I will bless the Lord at every time; continually his praise is in my mouth.

3 In the Lord my soul will be praised; let the meek hear and be glad.

4 Magnify the Lord with me, and let us exalt his name together.

5 I sought the Lord, and he heard me and rescued me from all my sojournings.

6 Draw near him and be enlightened, and your faces will certainly not be put to shame.

7 This poor man cried, and the Lord heard him and saved him from all his afflictions.

8 An angel of the Lord will encamp around those fearing him and rescue them.

9 Taste and see that the Lord is good; blessed is the man who hopes in him.

10 Fear the Lord, his holy ones, for there is no lack for those fearing him.

11 Rich men became poor and hungry, but those seeking the Lord will not be deprived of any good thing. Interlude.

12 Come, children, hear me; I will teach you fear of the Lord.

13 Who is the human desiring life, loving to see good days?

14 Stop your tongue from evil and your lips from speaking deceit.

15 Turn aside from evil and do good; seek peace and pursue it.

16 The Lord's eyes are upon the righteous, and his ears toward their petition.

17 But the Lord's face is against those doing evils, to destroy their remembrance from the earth.

18 The righteous cried, and the Lord heard them and rescued them from all their afflictions.

19 The Lord is near those broken in heart, and he will save the lowly in spirit.

20 Many are the afflictions of the righteous, and from all of them he will rescue them.

21 The Lord guards all their bones; not one of them will be shattered.

22 The death of sinners is evil, and those hating the righteous one will offend.

23 The Lord will redeem the souls of his servants, and all who hope in him will certainly not offend.

Chapter 34

1 For Dauid. Judge, Lord, those wronging me; wage war against those warring against me.

2 Take hold of a shield and a large shield, and rise to my help;

3 draw out a sword and close off against those pursuing me; say to my soul, “I am your salvation.”

4 Let those seeking my soul be ashamed and abashed; let those devising evils for me turn backward and be put to shame.

5 Let them become like chaff before the wind, and an angel of the Lord pressing them out;

6 let their way become darkness and slipping, and an angel of the Lord pursuing them;

7 for without cause they hid the destruction of their trap for me; in vain they reproached my soul.

8 Let a trap come to them that they do not know, and let the snare that they hid catch them, and they will fall in the trap, in it.

9 But my soul will exult in the Lord; it will delight in his salvation;

10 all my bones will say, “Lord, who is like you, rescuing a poor man from the hand of those stronger than he, and a poor and needy man from those plundering him?”

11 Unjust witnesses rose and questioned me about things I did not know;

12 they repaid me wicked things for good things, and childlessness for my soul.

13 But when they troubled me I clothed myself in sackcloth and humbled my soul with fasting, and my prayer will return into my bosom.

14 As for a neighbor, as for our brother, so I was well pleasing; as one mourning and looking gloomy, so I humbled myself.

15 And they were glad against me and gathered; scourges gathered against me, and I did not know; they were torn apart and were not pierced with remorse.

16 They tried me; they mocked me with mockery; they gnashed their teeth against me.

17 Lord, when will you look upon this? Restore my soul from their villainy, my only one from lions.

18 I will give thanks to you, Lord, in a large assembly; among a mighty people I will praise you.

19 May those unjustly hostile to me not rejoice over me, those hating me without cause and signaling with their eyes.

20 For they spoke peaceful things to me, but devised deceits toward anger,

21 and opened their mouth wide against me; they said, “Well done, well done, our eyes saw.”

22 You saw, Lord; do not keep silence; Lord, do not depart from me;

23 awake, Lord, and attend to my judgment, my God and my Lord, to my cause.

24 Judge me according to your righteousness, Lord my God, and may they not rejoice over me;

25 may they not say in their hearts, “Well done, well done for our soul”; nor may they say, “We swallowed him.”

26 May those rejoicing at my evils be ashamed and abashed together; let those boasting greatly against me clothe themselves in shame and disgrace.

27 May those desiring my righteousness exult and be glad, and let those desiring the peace of his servant say continually, “Let the Lord be magnified.”

28 And my tongue will meditate on your righteousness, on your praise the whole day.

Chapter 35

1 For the end; for the Lord's servant Dauid.

2 The lawless man speaks of sinning within himself; there is no fear of God before his eyes;

3 for he practiced deceit before him, to find his lawlessness and hate it.

4 The words of his mouth are lawlessness and deceit; he did not wish to understand so as to do good;

5 he devised lawlessness upon his bed; he stood in every way that is not good, but was not vexed at wickedness.

6 Lord, your mercy is in heaven, and your truth as far as the clouds;

7 your righteousness is like mountains of God; your judgments are a great abyss; you will save humans and beasts, Lord.

8 How you multiplied your mercy, God; and the sons of humans will hope in the shelter of your wings.

9 They will be intoxicated with the richness of your house, and you will give them the torrent of your delight to drink;

10 for with you is a spring of life; in your light we will see light.

11 Extend your mercy to those knowing you and your righteousness to the upright in heart.

12 Let a foot of arrogance not come to me, and may a hand of sinners not shake me.

13 There those working lawlessness fell; they were cast out and will certainly not be able to stand.

Chapter 36

1 Of Dauid. Do not be jealous among evildoers, nor envy those doing lawlessness;

2 for like grass they will quickly dry up, and like green herbs they will quickly fall away.

3 Hope in the Lord and do goodness and dwell in the earth, and you will be shepherded upon its wealth;

4 delight in the Lord, and he will give you the requests of your heart.

5 Uncover your way to the Lord and hope in him, and he himself will act

6 and bring out your righteousness like light and your judgment like midday.

7 Be subjected to the Lord and entreat him; do not be jealous of the one prospering in his way, of a human committing lawless acts.

8 Cease from wrath and abandon anger; do not be jealous so as to do evil;

9 for evildoers will be destroyed, but those waiting for the Lord themselves will inherit earth.

10 And yet a little while, and the sinner will certainly not exist, and you will seek his place and certainly not find it;

11 but the meek will inherit earth and delight in an abundance of peace.

12 The sinner will watch the righteous one and gnash his teeth against him;

13 but the Lord will laugh at him, for he foresees that his day will come.

14 Sinners drew a sword; they drew their bow to cast down a poor and needy man, to slaughter the upright in heart;

15 may their sword enter their heart, and may their bows be shattered.

16 A little for the righteous one is better than great wealth of sinners;

17 for sinners' arms will be shattered, but the Lord supports the righteous.

18 The Lord knows the ways of the blameless, and their inheritance will be forever;

19 they will not be put to shame in an evil time, and in days of famine they will be satisfied.

20 For sinners will perish, and the Lord's enemies, as soon as they are glorified and exalted, failing like smoke, failed.

21 The sinner borrows and will not repay, but the righteous one has compassion and gives;

22 for those blessing him will inherit earth, but those cursing him will be destroyed.

23 A human's steps are directed by the Lord, and he will desire his way;

24 when he falls, he will not be dashed down, for the Lord supports his hand.

25 I was younger and indeed grew old, and I did not see a righteous man abandoned, nor his seed seeking loaves;

26 the whole day he has mercy and lends, and his seed will be for a blessing.

27 Turn aside from evil and do good and dwell for the age of the age;

28 for the Lord loves judgment and will not abandon his holy ones; they will be guarded forever. But lawless ones will be driven out, and the seed of the impious will be destroyed;

29 but the righteous will inherit earth and dwell upon it for the age of the age.

30 A righteous one's mouth will meditate on wisdom, and his tongue will speak judgment;

31 the law of his God is in his heart, and his steps will not be tripped up.

32 The sinner observes the righteous one and seeks to put him to death,

33 but the Lord will certainly not abandon him into his hands, nor condemn him when he is judged against him.

34 Wait for the Lord and guard his way, and he will exalt you to inherit earth; when sinners are destroyed, you will see.

35 I saw an impious man greatly exalted and lifted up like the cedars of Libanos;

36 and I passed by, and look, he was not there, and I sought him, and his place was not found.

37 Guard innocence and see uprightness, for there is a remnant for a peaceful human;

38 but lawless men will be destroyed together; the remnants of the impious will be destroyed.

39 But the salvation of the righteous is from the Lord, and he is their defender in a time of affliction,

40 and the Lord will help them and rescue them and deliver them from sinners and save them, for they hoped in him.

Chapter 37

1 A psalm for Dauid; for remembrance concerning the sabbath.

2 Lord, do not rebuke me in your anger nor instruct me in your wrath.

3 For your arrows were fixed in me, and you pressed your hand upon me;

4 there is no healing in my flesh because of your wrath; there is no peace for my bones because of my sins.

5 For my lawless deeds rose over my head; like a heavy burden they weighed heavily upon me.

6 My bruises stank and rotted because of my folly;

7 I became miserable and was bowed down completely; the whole day I walked looking gloomy.

8 For my loins were filled with mockeries, and there is no healing in my flesh;

9 I was afflicted and humbled exceedingly; I roared from the groaning of my heart.

10 Lord, all my desire is before you, and my groaning was not hidden from you.

11 My heart was troubled; my strength abandoned me, and the light of my eyes, even it is not with me.

12 My friends and my neighbors drew near opposite me and stood, and those nearest me stood far away;

13 and those seeking my soul used force, and those seeking evils for me spoke vanities and meditated on deceits the whole day.

14 But I, like a deaf man, did not hear, and like a speechless man not opening his mouth,

15 and I became like a human not hearing and not having rebukes in his mouth.

16 For in you, Lord, I hoped; you will hear, Lord my God.

17 For I said, “Lest my enemies rejoice over me”; and when my feet were shaken they boasted greatly against me.

18 For I am ready for scourges, and my pain is before me continually.

19 For I will proclaim my lawlessness and be anxious about my sin.

20 But my enemies live and have become stronger than I, and those unjustly hating me multiplied;

21 those repaying evils for good things slandered me, since I pursued righteousness, [and they cast me, the beloved one, away like an abhorred dead man.]

22 Do not abandon me, Lord; my God, do not depart from me;

23 attend to my help, Lord of my salvation.

Chapter 38

1 For the end, for Idithoun; a song for Dauid.

2 I said, “I will guard my ways so as not to sin with my tongue”; I placed a guard at my mouth when the sinner stood before me.

3 I became deaf and was humbled and kept silence from good things, and my pain was renewed.

4 My heart grew hot within me, and in my meditation fire will be kindled. I spoke with my tongue:

5 “Make known to me, Lord, my end and the number of my days, what it is, so that I may know what I lack.

6 Look, you made my days handbreadths, and my existence is like nothing before you; surely all things are vanity, every living human.” Interlude.

7 Indeed, a human passes along in an image; surely they are troubled in vain; he treasures up and does not know for whom he will gather them.

8 And now what is my waiting? Is it not the Lord? And my existence is from you.

9 Rescue me from all my lawless deeds; you gave me as a reproach to a fool.

10 I became deaf and did not open my mouth, for you are the one who made me.

11 Remove your scourges from me; from the strength of your hand I failed.

12 With rebukes for lawlessness you instructed a human and melted his soul like a spider; surely every human is troubled in vain. Interlude.

13 Hear my prayer, Lord, and give ear to my petition; do not keep silence at my tears, for I am a sojourner with you and a stranger, as all my fathers.

14 Release me, so that I may be refreshed before I depart and no longer exist.

Chapter 39

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Waiting, I waited for the Lord, and he attended to me and heard my petition

3 and brought me up from a pit of misery and from mud of mire, and set my feet upon a rock and directed my steps,

4 and put a new song into my mouth, a hymn to our God; many will see and fear and hope in the Lord.

5 Blessed is the man whose hope is the Lord's name, and who did not look toward vanities and false frenzies.

6 You did many things, Lord my God, your wonders, and in your thoughts there is no one who will be likened to you; I proclaimed and spoke; they multiplied beyond number.

7 You did not desire sacrifice and offering, but you fashioned ears for me; you did not ask for a whole burnt offering and an offering for sin.

8 Then I said, “Look, I have come; in a scroll of a book it has been written concerning me;

9 I wished to do your will, my God, and your law is in the midst of my belly.”

10 I proclaimed righteousness as good news in a great assembly; look, I will certainly not restrain my lips; Lord, you knew.

11 I did not hide your righteousness in my heart; I spoke your truth and your salvation; I did not hide your mercy and your truth from a large gathering.

12 But you, Lord, do not put your compassions far from me; your mercy and your truth helped me continually.

13 For evils surrounded me, of which there is no number; my lawless deeds overtook me, and I could not see; they multiplied beyond the hairs of my head, and my heart abandoned me.

14 Be pleased, Lord, to rescue me; Lord, attend to helping me.

15 May those seeking my soul to remove it be put to shame and abashed together; may those desiring evils for me turn backward and be abashed;

16 let those saying to me, “Well done, well done,” receive their shame immediately.

17 May all who seek you exult and be glad in you, Lord, and let those loving your salvation say continually, “Let the Lord be magnified.”

18 But I am poor and needy; the Lord will care for me. You are my helper and my defender; my God, do not delay.

Chapter 40

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Blessed is the one understanding concerning a poor and needy man; in an evil day the Lord will rescue him.

3 May the Lord preserve him and make him live and pronounce him blessed on the earth, and may he not deliver him into his enemy's hands.

4 May the Lord help him upon his bed of pain; you turned his whole bed in his sickness.

5 I said, “Lord, have mercy on me; heal my soul, for I sinned against you.”

6 My enemies spoke evils against me: “When will he die and his name perish?”

7 And if he entered to see, he spoke vainly; his heart gathered lawlessness for itself; he went outside and spoke.

8 All my enemies whispered together against me; against me they devised evils for me;

9 they laid down a lawless word against me: “Surely the one lying down will not rise again?”

10 For even the human of my peace, in whom I hoped, the one eating my loaves, magnified a heel-trip against me;

11 but you, Lord, have mercy on me and raise me, and I will repay them.

12 By this I knew that you have desired me, for my enemy will certainly not rejoice over me.

13 But you helped me because of innocence, and you established me before you forever.

14 Blessed is the Lord, the God of Israel, from eternity and unto eternity. May it be, may it be. – –

Chapter 41

1 For the end; for understanding, for the sons of Kore.

2 As the deer longs for the springs of the waters, so my soul longs for you, God.

3 My soul thirsted for the living God; when will I come and appear before God's face?

4 My tears became bread for me by day and by night, while it was said to me every day, “Where is your God?”

5 I remembered these things and poured out my soul upon me, for I will pass through the place of a wondrous tent as far as God's house, with a voice of exultation and thanksgiving, a sound of one celebrating a feast.

6 Why are you sorrowful, soul, and why do you trouble me? Hope in God, for I will give thanks to him; my God is the salvation of my face.

7 My soul was troubled within myself; because of this I will remember you from the land of Iordanes and Ermoniim, from a small mountain.

8 Abyss calls upon abyss at the sound of your waterfalls; all your surges and your waves passed over me.

9 By day the Lord will command his mercy, and by night a song is with me, a prayer to the God of my life.

10 I will say to God, “You are my helper; why did you forget me? Why do I walk looking gloomy while my enemy oppresses?”

11 While my bones were crushed, those afflicting me reproached me, saying to me every day, “Where is your God?”

12 Why are you sorrowful, soul, and why do you trouble me? Hope in God, for I will give thanks to him; my God is the salvation of my face.

Chapter 42

1 A psalm for Dauid. Judge me, God, and judge my cause against an unholy nation; rescue me from an unjust and deceitful human.

2 For you, God, are my strength; why did you reject me? And why do I walk looking gloomy while my enemy oppresses?

3 Send out your light and your truth; these guided me and brought me to your holy mountain and to your dwellings.

4 And I will enter toward God's altar, toward God who gladdens my youth; I will give thanks to you with a lyre, God, my God.

5 Why are you sorrowful, soul, and why do you trouble me? Hope in God, for I will give thanks to him; my God is the salvation of my face.

Chapter 43

1 For the end; for the sons of Kore, a psalm for understanding.

2 God, we heard with our ears; our fathers proclaimed to us a work that you worked in their days, in ancient days.

3 Your hand destroyed nations, and you planted them; you afflicted peoples and cast them out.

4 For they did not inherit earth by their sword, and their arm did not save them, but your right hand and your arm and the enlightenment of your face, for you were pleased with them.

5 You yourself are my king and my God, commanding the salvations of Iakob;

6 in you we will gore our enemies, and in your name we will despise those rising against us.

7 For I will not hope in my bow, and my sword will not save me;

8 for you saved us from those afflicting us and put those hating us to shame.

9 In God we will be praised the whole day, and in your name we will give thanks forever. Interlude.

10 But now you rejected and put us to shame, and you will not go out with our hosts;

11 you turned us backward before our enemies, and those hating us plundered for themselves.

12 You gave us like sheep for eating and scattered us among the nations;

13 you sold your people without a price, and there was no abundance in their exchanges.

14 You made us a reproach to our neighbors, mockery and ridicule to those around us;

15 you made us a parable among the nations, a movement of the head among the peoples.

16 The whole day my disgrace is before me, and the shame of my face covered me,

17 from the voice of one reproaching and speaking abusively, from the presence of an enemy and persecutor.

18 All these things came upon us, and we did not forget you and did not act unjustly in your covenant,

19 and our heart did not depart backward; and you turned our paths aside from your way.

20 For you humbled us in a place of affliction, and a shadow of death covered us.

21 If we forgot the name of our God and if we spread out our hands toward a foreign god,

22 will not God seek these things out? For he himself knows the hidden things of the heart.

23 For because of you we are put to death the whole day; we were reckoned like sheep for slaughter.

24 Awake; why do you sleep, Lord? Rise and do not reject completely.

25 Why do you turn away your face, forget our poverty and our affliction?

26 For our soul was humbled into dust; our belly stuck to the earth.

27 Rise, Lord; help us and redeem us for the sake of your name.

Chapter 44

1 For the end, concerning those who will be changed; for the sons of Kore, for understanding; a song concerning the beloved one.

2 My heart poured forth a good word; I speak my works to the king; my tongue is a reed of a swift-writing scribe.

3 Beautiful in beauty beyond the sons of humans, grace was poured out on your lips; because of this God blessed you forever.

4 Gird your sword upon your thigh, mighty one, in your beauty and your comeliness,

5 and draw and prosper and reign for the sake of truth and meekness and righteousness, and your right hand will guide you wondrously.

6 Your arrows are sharpened, mighty one—peoples will fall beneath you—in the heart of the king's enemies.

7 Your throne, God, is for the age of the age; a rod of uprightness is the rod of your kingdom.

8 You loved righteousness and hated lawlessness; because of this God, your God, anointed you with oil of exultation beyond your companions.

9 Myrrh and stacte and cassia are from your garments, from ivory palaces, from which they gladdened you.

10 Kings' daughters are in your honor; the queen stood at your right, clothed in gold-woven clothing, adorned in varied colors.

11 Hear, daughter, and see and incline your ear, and forget your people and your father's house,

12 for the king desired your beauty, for he himself is your lord.

13 And daughters of Tyros will bow to him with gifts; the rich of the people will entreat your face.

14 All her glory, a king's daughter, is within, clothed in golden fringes, adorned in varied colors.

15 Virgins will be brought to the king behind her; her companions will be brought to you;

16 they will be brought with gladness and exultation; they will be led into a king's temple.

17 In place of your fathers sons came to be for you; you will appoint them rulers over all the earth.

18 They will remember your name in every generation and generation; because of this peoples will give thanks to you forever and for the age of the age.

Chapter 45

1 For the end; concerning the sons of Kore, a psalm concerning the hidden things.

2 Our God is refuge and power, a helper in the afflictions that found us exceedingly.

3 Because of this we will not fear when the earth is troubled and mountains are moved into the hearts of seas.

4 Their waters roared and were troubled; the mountains were troubled in his might. Interlude.

5 The river's rushes gladden God's city; the Most High sanctified his dwelling.

6 God is in its midst; it will not be shaken; God will help it toward morning.

7 Nations were troubled; kingdoms inclined; he gave his voice; the earth was shaken.

8 The Lord of powers is with us; our helper is the God of Iakob. Interlude.

9 Come, see the Lord's works, the wonders he placed upon the earth.

10 Removing wars as far as the ends of the earth, he will shatter a bow and break a weapon and burn shields in fire.

11 Be at rest and know that I am God; I will be exalted among the nations; I will be exalted on the earth.

12 The Lord of powers is with us; our helper is the God of Iakob.

Chapter 46

1 For the end; concerning the sons of Kore, a psalm.

2 All the nations, clap your hands; shout to God with a voice of exultation,

3 because the Lord Most High is fearsome, a great king over all the earth.

4 He subjected peoples to us and nations beneath our feet;

5 he chose for us his inheritance, the beauty of Iakob, which he loved. Interlude.

6 God ascended with a shout, the Lord with the sound of a trumpet.

7 Sing to our God, sing; sing to our king, sing,

8 because God is king of all the earth; sing with understanding.

9 God reigned over the nations; God sits upon his holy throne.

10 Rulers of peoples were gathered with the God of Abraam, because the mighty ones of the earth belong to God; they were greatly exalted.

Chapter 47

1 A psalm of a song for the sons of Kore; on the second day of the week.

2 Great is the Lord and greatly praiseworthy in the city of our God, his holy mountain,

3 taking root well for the rejoicing of all the earth. Mountains of Sion, the sides of the north, the city of the great king,

4 God is known in her citadels when he takes hold of her.

5 Because, behold, the kings were gathered; they came together;

6 they, seeing thus, marveled; they were troubled, they were shaken;

7 trembling took hold of them; there were birth pangs there, as of a woman giving birth.

8 With a violent wind you will shatter ships of Tharsis.

9 Just as we heard, so we saw in the city of the Lord of powers, in the city of our God; God founded her forever. Interlude.

10 We received your mercy, God, in the midst of your temple.

11 According to your name, God, so also is your praise to the ends of the earth; your right hand is full of righteousness.

12 Let Mount Sion rejoice; let the daughters of Ioudaia exult because of your judgments, Lord.

13 Circle Sion and encompass her; recount her towers;

14 Set your hearts upon her strength and examine her citadels, so that you may recount to another generation.

15 Because this is God, our God, forever and for the age of the age; he will shepherd us for the ages.

Chapter 48

1 For the end; for the sons of Kore, a psalm.

2 Hear these things, all the nations; give ear, all who inhabit the inhabited world,

3 both the earthborn and the sons of humans, rich and poor together.

4 My mouth will speak wisdom, and the meditation of my heart, understanding;

5 I will incline my ear to a parable; I will open my riddle with a psaltery.

6 Why am I afraid on an evil day? The lawlessness of my heel will surround me.

7 Those who trust in their strength and boast in the multitude of their wealth,

8 a brother is not redeemed; will a human redeem? He will not give God his propitiation

9 and the price of the redemption of his soul.

10 And he ceased forever and will live to the end, because he will not see destruction when he sees wise ones dying.

11 Together the foolish and the senseless will perish and will leave their wealth to strangers,

12 and their graves are their houses forever, their dwellings to generation and generation. They called their names upon their lands.

13 And a human, being in honor, did not understand; he was compared to the senseless beasts and became like them.

14 This way of theirs is a stumbling block to them, and after these things they will take pleasure in their mouth. Interlude.

15 Like sheep they were placed in Hades; death shepherds them. And the upright will rule over them in the morning, and their help will grow old in Hades away from their glory.

16 But God will redeem my soul from the hand of Hades when he takes me. Interlude.

17 Do not be afraid when a human becomes rich and when the glory of his house is multiplied,

18 because when he dies he will not take everything, nor will his glory descend with him.

19 Because his soul will be blessed in his life; he will acknowledge you when you do good to him.

20 He will enter as far as the generation of his fathers; forever he will not see light.

21 A human, being in honor, did not understand; he was compared to the senseless beasts and became like them.

Chapter 49

1 A psalm for Asaph. The God of gods, the Lord, spoke and called the earth from the rising of the sun and as far as its setting.

2 From Sion is the magnificence of his beauty; God will come visibly,

3 our God, and he will not keep silent. Fire will burn before him, and around him a very great storm.

4 He will summon heaven above and the earth to judge his people:

5 Gather to him his holy ones, those making his covenant upon sacrifices,

6 and the heavens will announce his righteousness, because God is judge. Interlude.

7 Hear, my people, and I will speak to you, Israel, and I testify to you; I am God, your God.

8 I will not reprove you for your sacrifices, and your whole burnt offerings are before me continually;

9 I will not receive calves from your house or he-goats from your flocks.

10 Because all the wild beasts of the forest are mine, beasts on the mountains and oxen;

11 I have known all the birds of heaven, and the beauty of the field is with me.

12 If I hunger, I will certainly not tell you; for the inhabited world is mine, and its fullness.

13 Surely I will not eat the flesh of bulls or drink the blood of goats?

14 Sacrifice to God a sacrifice of praise, and pay your vows to the Most High;

15 and call upon me on a day of affliction, and I will deliver you, and you will glorify me. Interlude.

16 But to the sinner God said: Why do you recount my ordinances and take up my covenant through your mouth?

17 But you hated discipline and cast my words behind you.

18 If you saw a thief, you ran together with him, and you placed your portion with adulterers;

19 your mouth abounded in evil, and your tongue wove deceit;

20 sitting, you spoke against your brother, and against the son of your mother you placed a stumbling block.

21 You did these things, and I kept silent; you supposed lawlessness, that I would be like you; I will reprove you and set it before your face.

22 Understand these things, then, you who forget God, lest he seize and there be no one delivering;

23 A sacrifice of praise will glorify me, and there is a way there by which I will show him the salvation of God.

Chapter 50

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid,

2 when Nathan the prophet came to him, when he went in to Bersabee.

3 Have mercy on me, God, according to your great mercy, and according to the multitude of your compassions blot out my lawless deed;

4 Wash me still more from my lawlessness, and cleanse me from my sin.

5 Because I know my lawlessness, and my sin is before me continually.

6 Against you alone I sinned and did what is evil before you, so that you may be justified in your words and prevail when you are judged.

7 For behold, in lawless deeds I was conceived, and in sins my mother conceived me.

8 For behold, you loved truth; the unrevealed and hidden things of your wisdom you made known to me.

9 You will sprinkle me with hyssop, and I will be cleansed; you will wash me, and I will be made whiter than snow.

10 You will make me hear exultation and gladness; humbled bones will exult.

11 Turn your face away from my sins, and blot out all my lawless deeds.

12 Create a clean heart in me, God, and renew an upright spirit in my inward parts.

13 Do not cast me away from your face, and do not take your holy spirit away from me.

14 Restore to me the exultation of your salvation, and support me with a ruling spirit.

15 I will teach lawless ones your ways, and impious ones will turn back to you.

16 Deliver me from bloods, God, the God of my salvation; my tongue will exult in your righteousness.

17 Lord, you will open my lips, and my mouth will announce your praise.

18 Because if you had wanted a sacrifice, I would have given it; you will not take pleasure in whole burnt offerings.

19 A sacrifice to God is a broken spirit; a broken and humbled heart God will not despise.

20 Do good to Sion, Lord, in your good pleasure, and let the walls of Ierousalem be built;

21 then you will take pleasure in a sacrifice of righteousness, an offering and whole burnt offerings; then they will offer calves upon your altar.

Chapter 51

1 For the end; of understanding, for Dauid,

2 when Doek the Idumaian came and announced to Saoul and said to him: Dauid came into the house of Abimelech.

3 Why do you boast in evil, mighty one, of lawlessness all day?

4 Your tongue devised injustice; like a sharpened razor you worked deceit.

5 You loved evil more than goodness, injustice more than speaking righteousness. Interlude.

6 You loved all words of drowning, a deceitful tongue.

7 For this reason God will pull you down to the end; may he pluck you out and remove you from your dwelling, and your root from the land of the living. Interlude.

8 And righteous ones will see and be afraid, and will laugh at him and say:

9 Behold, a human who did not make God his helper, but hoped in the multitude of his wealth and was strengthened in his vanity.

10 But I am like a fruitful olive tree in the house of God; I hoped in the mercy of God forever and for the age of the age.

11 I will acknowledge you forever, because you acted, and I will wait for your name, because it is good before your holy ones.

Chapter 52

1 For the end, concerning maeleth; of understanding, for Dauid.

2 A fool said in his heart: There is no God. They became corrupt and abominable in lawless deeds; there is no one doing good.

3 God leaned down from heaven upon the sons of humans to see whether there is anyone understanding or seeking out God.

4 All turned aside; together they became useless; there is no one doing good, there is not even one.

5 Will not all who work lawlessness know? Those eating my people as food of bread did not call upon God.

6 There they will fear a fear where there was no fear, because God scattered the bones of those pleasing humans; they were put to shame, because God despised them.

7 Who will give the salvation of Israel from Sion? When the Lord turns back the captivity of his people, Iakob will exult and Israel will rejoice.

Chapter 53

1 For the end, in hymns; of understanding, for Dauid,

2 when the Ziphaians came and said to Saoul: Behold, is not Dauid hidden among us?

3 God, save me by your name, and judge me by your strength.

4 God, hear my prayer; give ear to the words of my mouth.

5 Because strangers rose against me, and mighty ones sought my soul; they did not set God before them. Interlude.

6 For behold, God helps me, and the Lord is the supporter of my soul.

7 He will turn the evils back upon my enemies; in your truth destroy them.

8 Willingly I will sacrifice to you; I will acknowledge your name, Lord, because it is good;

9 because you delivered me from every affliction, and my eye looked upon my enemies.

Chapter 54

1 For the end, in hymns; of understanding, for Dauid.

2 Give ear, God, to my prayer, and do not overlook my supplication;

3 attend to me and hear me. I was grieved in my meditation and troubled

4 by the voice of an enemy and by the affliction of a sinner, because they turned lawlessness upon me and bore a grudge against me in wrath.

5 My heart was troubled within me, and dread of death fell upon me;

6 fear and trembling came upon me, and darkness covered me.

7 And I said: Who will give me wings like a dove, and I will fly and rest?

8 Behold, I went far away in flight and lodged in the wilderness. Interlude.

9 I awaited the one saving me from faintheartedness and storm.

10 Drown them, Lord, and divide their tongues, because I saw lawlessness and contradiction in the city.

11 Day and night it will circle her upon her walls; lawlessness and toil are in her midst, and injustice,

12 and interest and deceit did not cease from her squares.

13 Because if an enemy had reproached me, I would have endured it, and if the one hating me had spoken boastfully against me, I would have hidden from him.

14 But you, human of equal soul, my leader and my acquaintance,

15 who together with me made foods sweet, we walked in the house of God in concord;

16 let death come upon them, and let them descend alive into Hades, because evils are in their sojournings, in their midst.

17 But I cried out to God, and the Lord heard me.

18 At evening and morning and midday I will recount; I will report, and he will hear my voice.

19 He will redeem my soul in peace from those approaching me, because among many they were with me.

20 God will hear and humble them, the one existing before the ages. Interlude. For there is no exchange for them, and they did not fear God.

21 He stretched out his hand in repaying; they profaned his covenant.

22 They were divided by the wrath of his face, and his heart drew near; his words were softened more than oil, and they are missiles.

23 Cast your care upon the Lord, and he will sustain you; he will never give shaking to the righteous one.

24 But you, God, will bring them down into a pit of corruption; men of bloods and deceit will certainly not reach half their days. But I will hope in you, Lord.

Chapter 55

1 For the end, concerning the people removed far from the holy places; for Dauid, for an inscription on a pillar, when the foreigners seized him in Geth.

2 Have mercy on me, Lord, because a human trampled me; fighting all day, he afflicted me.

3 My enemies trampled me all day, because many are those fighting me from a height.

4 By day I will be afraid, but I will hope in you.

5 In God I will praise my words all day. In God I hoped; I will not be afraid. What will flesh do to me?

6 All day they abhorred my words; all their reasonings against me are for evil.

7 They will sojourn and hide; they will watch my heel, just as they waited for my soul.

8 For nothing you will save them; in wrath you will bring peoples down, God.

9 I declared my life to you; you placed my tears before you, as also in your promise.

10 My enemies will turn backward on whatever day I call upon you; behold, I knew that you are my God.

11 In God I will praise an utterance; in the Lord I will praise a word.

12 In God I hoped; I will not be afraid. What will a human do to me?

13 Within me, God, are the vows of praise that I will pay to you,

14 because you delivered my soul from death and my feet from slipping, to be pleasing before God in the light of the living.

Chapter 56

1 For the end; do not destroy; for Dauid, for an inscription on a pillar, when he fled from the face of Saoul into the cave.

2 Have mercy on me, God, have mercy on me, because my soul has trusted in you, and in the shadow of your wings I will hope until lawlessness passes away.

3 I will cry out to God Most High, the God who benefited me.

4 He sent forth from heaven and saved me; he gave those trampling me to reproach. Interlude. God sent forth his mercy and his truth

5 and delivered my soul from the midst of young lions. I lay down troubled; sons of humans, their teeth are a weapon and arrows, and their tongue a sharp sword.

6 Be exalted above the heavens, God, and your glory above all the earth.

7 They prepared a trap for my feet and bent down my soul; they dug a pit before my face and fell into it. Interlude.

8 My heart is ready, God, my heart is ready; I will sing and make music.

9 Awake, my glory; awake, psaltery and lyre; I will awake at dawn.

10 I will acknowledge you among peoples, Lord; I will sing to you among nations,

11 because your mercy was magnified as far as the heavens, and your truth as far as the clouds.

12 Be exalted above the heavens, God, and your glory above all the earth.

Chapter 57

1 For the end; do not destroy; for Dauid, for an inscription on a pillar.

2 Do you truly, then, speak righteousness? Do you judge upright things, sons of humans?

3 For indeed you work lawless deeds in your heart on the earth; your hands weave injustice.

4 Sinners were estranged from the womb; they strayed from the belly; they spoke lies.

5 Their fury is according to the likeness of the serpent, like a deaf asp stopping its ears,

6 which will not hear the voice of enchanters or a charm worked by a wise one.

7 God shattered their teeth in their mouth; the Lord crushed the molars of lions.

8 They will be brought to nothing like water passing through; he will draw his bow until they grow weak.

9 Like melted wax they will be taken away; fire fell upon them, and they did not see the sun.

10 Before your thorns understand the buckthorn, he will swallow you as though alive, as though in wrath.

11 A righteous one will rejoice when he sees vengeance upon impious ones; he will wash his hands in the blood of the sinner.

12 And a human will say: Indeed, then, there is fruit for the righteous one; indeed, there is God judging them on the earth.

Chapter 58

1 For the end; do not destroy; for Dauid, for an inscription on a pillar, when Saoul sent and watched his house to put him to death.

2 Deliver me from my enemies, God, and redeem me from those rising against me;

3 deliver me from those working lawlessness, and save me from men of bloods.

4 Because, behold, they hunted my soul; mighty ones attacked me. Neither my lawlessness nor my sin, Lord;

5 without lawlessness they ran and directed their course; awake to meet me and see.

6 And you, Lord, the God of powers, the God of Israel, attend to visiting all the nations; do not pity all those working lawlessness. Interlude.

7 They will return toward evening and hunger like a dog and circle a city.

8 Behold, they will utter with their mouth, and a sword is in their lips; because who heard?

9 And you, Lord, will laugh at them; you will despise all the nations.

10 My strength, I will watch toward you, because you, God, are my supporter.

11 My God, his mercy will go before me; God will show me among my enemies.

12 Do not kill them, lest they forget my people; scatter them by your strength and bring them down, Lord, my defender.

13 The sin of their mouth, the word of their lips, and let them be caught in their arrogance; and from curse and falsehood ends will be proclaimed

14 in wrath of an end, and they will certainly not exist; and they will know that God rules Iakob, the ends of the earth. Interlude.

15 They will return toward evening and hunger like a dog and circle a city.

16 They will be scattered to eat; but if they are not filled, they will also grumble.

17 But I will sing of your strength and exult in your mercy in the morning, because you became my supporter and a refuge on the day of my affliction.

18 My helper, I will sing to you, because you, God, are my supporter, my God, my mercy.

Chapter 59

1 For the end; for those who will yet be changed, for an inscription on a pillar, for Dauid, for teaching,

2 when he burned the Mesopotamia of Syria and Syria Soba, and Ioab returned and struck the ravine of salts, twelve thousand.

3 God, you rejected us and pulled us down; you were angry and pitied us.

4 You shook the earth and troubled it; heal its fractures, because it was shaken.

5 You showed your people hard things; you gave us wine of stupefaction to drink.

6 You gave those fearing you a signal to flee from the face of a bow. Interlude.

7 So that your beloved ones may be delivered, save with your right hand and hear me.

8 God spoke in his holy place: I will exult and divide Sikima, and I will measure out the valley of tents;

9 Galaad is mine, and Manasse is mine, and Ephraim is the strengthening of my head, Ioudas my king;

10 Moab is the cauldron of my hope; upon Idumaia I will extend my sandal; foreigners were subjected to me.

11 Who will lead me into a fortified city? Who will guide me as far as Idumaia?

12 Is it not you, God, who rejected us? And you will not go out, God, with our forces.

13 Give us help out of affliction; and a human's salvation is vain.

14 But in God we will do mighty deeds, and he will bring to nothing those afflicting us.

Chapter 60

1 For the end, in hymns; for Dauid.

2 Hear, God, my supplication; attend to my prayer.

3 From the ends of the earth I cried out to you when my heart grew weary; upon a rock you raised me,

4 you guided me, because you became my hope, a tower of strength from the face of an enemy.

5 I will sojourn in your dwelling for the ages; I will be sheltered in the shelter of your wings. Interlude.

6 Because you, God, heard my vows; you gave an inheritance to those fearing your name.

7 You will add days to the days of a king, his years as far as the days of generation and generation.

8 He will remain forever before God; who will seek out his mercy and truth?

9 Thus I will sing to your name for the age of the age, that I may pay my vows day by day.

Chapter 61

1 For the end, concerning Idithoun; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Will not my soul be subjected to God? For from him is my salvation;

3 for indeed he is my God and my savior, my supporter; I will certainly not be shaken further.

4 Until when do you attack a human? You all murder, as against a leaning wall and a fence thrust aside.

5 But they planned to thrust away my honor; they ran in falsehood; with their mouth they blessed, and with their heart they cursed. Interlude.

6 But be subjected to God, my soul, because from him is my endurance;

7 because he is my God and my savior, my supporter; I will certainly not be displaced.

8 Upon God depend my salvation and my glory; the God of my help, and my hope is upon God.

9 Hope in him, every assembly of a people; pour out your hearts before him; God is our helper. Interlude.

10 But vain are the sons of humans, false are the sons of humans in balances for doing injustice; they are from vanity together.

11 Do not hope in injustice, and do not long for plunder; if wealth flows, do not set your heart upon it.

12 Once God spoke; these two things I heard:

13 that strength belongs to God, and to you, Lord, belongs mercy, because you will repay each one according to his works.

Chapter 62

1 A psalm for Dauid when he was in the wilderness of Ioudaia.

2 God, my God, toward you I rise early; my soul thirsted for you. How manifold is my flesh's longing for you in a land deserted and untrodden and waterless?

3 Thus in the holy place I appeared to you, to see your strength and your glory.

4 Because your mercy is better than lives; my lips will praise you.

5 Thus I will bless you in my life; in your name I will lift my hands.

6 May my soul be filled as with fat and richness, and with lips of exultation my mouth will praise.

7 If I remembered you upon my bed, at dawn I meditated upon you;

8 because you became my helper, and in the shelter of your wings I will exult.

9 My soul clung behind you; your right hand took hold of me.

10 But they sought my soul in vain; they will enter the lowest parts of the earth;

11 they will be handed over to the hands of a sword; they will be portions of foxes.

12 But the king will rejoice in God; everyone swearing by him will be praised, because the mouth of those speaking unjust things was stopped.

Chapter 63

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Hear, God, my voice when I supplicate; deliver my soul from fear of an enemy.

3 You sheltered me from a conspiracy of those doing evil, from a multitude of those working lawlessness,

4 who sharpened their tongues like a sword, drew their bow, a bitter thing,

5 to shoot down a blameless one in hidden places; suddenly they will shoot him down and will not be afraid.

6 They strengthened an evil word for themselves; they spoke of hiding traps; they said: Who will see them?

7 They searched out lawless deeds; they failed while searching with a search. A human will approach, and a deep heart,

8 and God will be exalted. Their blows became an arrow of infants,

9 and their tongues grew weak against them. All who saw them were troubled,

10 and every human was afraid. And they announced the works of God and understood his deeds.

11 A righteous one will rejoice in the Lord and hope in him, and all the upright in heart will be praised.

Chapter 64

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid, a song; of Ieremias and Iezekiel, from the account of the sojourning, when they were about to go out.

2 A hymn befits you, God, in Sion, and a vow will be paid to you in Ierousalem.

3 Hear my prayer; all flesh will come to you.

4 Words of lawless deeds overpowered us, and you will atone for our impieties.

5 Blessed is the one whom you chose and took to yourself; he will dwell in your courts. We will be filled with the good things of your house; your temple is holy, marvelous in righteousness.

6 Hear us, God our savior, the hope of all the ends of the earth and of those far away at sea,

7 preparing mountains by his strength, girded with might,

8 the one troubling the hollow of the sea, the sounds of its waves. The nations will be troubled,

9 and those inhabiting the ends will be afraid because of your signs; you will delight the departures of morning and evening.

10 You visited the earth and drenched it; you multiplied its enrichment; the river of God was filled with waters; you prepared their food, because thus is your preparation.

11 Drench its furrows; multiply its produce; in its drops it will rejoice as it sprouts.

12 You will bless the crown of the year of your goodness, and your plains will be filled with richness;

13 the beautiful places of the wilderness will grow fat, and the hills will gird themselves with exultation.

14 The rams of the sheep clothed themselves, and the valleys multiply grain; they will cry out, for indeed they will sing hymns.

Chapter 65

1 For the end; a song of a psalm; [of resurrection.] Shout to God, all the earth,

2 sing, then, to his name; give glory to his praise.

3 Say to God: How fearsome are your works; in the multitude of your strength your enemies will lie to you;

4 let all the earth bow to you and sing to you; let them sing to your name. Interlude.

5 Come and see the works of God; fearsome in counsels beyond the sons of humans,

6 the one turning the sea into dry land; in a river they will pass through on foot. There we will rejoice in him,

7 the one ruling by his might forever; his eyes look upon the nations; let those provoking bitterness not exalt themselves. Interlude.

8 Bless our God, nations, and make the voice of his praise heard,

9 the one who placed my soul into life and did not give my feet to shaking.

10 Because you tested us, God; you refined us by fire, as silver is refined by fire;

11 you brought us into the trap; you placed afflictions upon our back.

12 You mounted humans upon our heads; we passed through fire and water, and you brought us out into refreshment.

13 I will enter your house with whole burnt offerings; I will pay you my vows,

14 which my lips declared and my mouth spoke in my affliction;

15 whole burnt offerings full of marrow I will offer to you with incense and rams; I will prepare oxen with he-goats for you. Interlude.

16 Come, hear, all who fear God, and I will recount all that he did for my soul.

17 To him I cried out with my mouth and exalted beneath my tongue:

18 If I beheld injustice in my heart, let the Lord not hear.

19 For this reason God heard me; he attended to the voice of my supplication.

20 Blessed is God, who did not remove my prayer and his mercy from me.

Chapter 66

1 For the end, in hymns; a psalm of a song.

2 May God pity us and bless us; may he make his face shine upon us. Interlude.

3 That your way may be known on the earth, your salvation among all nations.

4 Let peoples acknowledge you, God; let all peoples acknowledge you.

5 Let nations rejoice and exult, because you will judge peoples in uprightness and guide nations on the earth. Interlude.

6 Let peoples acknowledge you, God; let all peoples acknowledge you.

7 The earth gave its fruit; may God, our God, bless us.

8 May God bless us, and let all the ends of the earth fear him.

Chapter 67

1 For the end; for Dauid, a psalm of a song.

2 Let God arise, and let his enemies be scattered, and let those hating him flee from his face.

3 As smoke fails, let them fail; as wax melts before the face of fire, so may sinners perish before the face of God.

4 And let the righteous rejoice; let them exult before God; let them delight in gladness.

5 Sing to God; sing to his name; make a road for the one riding upon the west; Lord is his name, and exult before him. They will be troubled before his face,

6 the father of orphans and judge of widows; God is in his holy place.

7 God settles solitary ones in a house, bringing out those bound in fetters with courage, likewise those provoking bitterness, those dwelling in graves.

8 God, when you went out before your people, when you passed through the wilderness, Interlude.

9 the earth shook, for indeed the heavens dripped before the face of God, this Sina, before the face of the God of Israel.

10 You will set apart a willing rain, God, for your inheritance, and it grew weak, but you restored it.

11 Your living creatures dwell in it; you prepared for the poor one in your goodness, God.

12 The Lord will give an utterance to those announcing good news with much power,

13 the king of the forces of the beloved, and for the beauty of the house to divide spoils.

14 If you lie down between the allotted portions, wings of a dove overlaid with silver, and her back with the greenish hue of gold. Interlude.

15 When the heavenly one distinguishes kings upon it, they will be made snowy in Selmon.

16 A mountain of God, a rich mountain, a curdled mountain, a rich mountain.

17 Why do you suppose, curdled mountains, the mountain in which God was pleased to dwell? For indeed the Lord will dwell to the end.

18 The chariot of God is ten-thousandfold, thousands of those flourishing; the Lord is among them, in Sina, in the holy place.

19 You ascended to a height; you took captivity captive; you received gifts among humans, for indeed disobedient ones, to dwell. The Lord God is blessed,

20 blessed is the Lord day by day; the God of our salvations will prosper our way. Interlude.

21 Our God is a God of saving, and to the Lord, the Lord, belong the exits of death.

22 But God will crush the heads of his enemies, the hairy crown of those walking in their transgressions.

23 The Lord said: From Basan I will turn back; I will turn back in the depths of the sea,

24 so that your foot may be dipped in blood, the tongue of your dogs from enemies, from him.

25 Your processions were seen, God, the processions of my God, the king in the holy place.

26 Rulers went ahead, followed by those making music, in the midst of young women playing tambourines.

27 In assemblies bless God, the Lord, from the springs of Israel.

28 There is Beniamin the younger in ecstasy, rulers of Iouda, their leaders, rulers of Zaboulon, rulers of Nephthali.

29 Command, God, your strength; strengthen, God, this which you accomplished for us.

30 From your temple at Ierousalem kings will bring gifts to you.

31 Rebuke the wild beasts of the reed; the assembly of bulls among the heifers of the peoples, so that those tested by silver may not be shut out; scatter nations that desire wars.

32 Ambassadors will come from Egypt; Ethiopia will hasten her hand to God.

33 Kingdoms of the earth, sing to God; sing to the Lord. Interlude.

34 Sing to God, the one riding upon the heaven of heaven toward the east; behold, he will give with his voice a voice of power.

35 Give glory to God; his magnificence is over Israel, and his strength is in the clouds.

36 Marvelous is God in his holy places; the God of Israel himself will give strength and strengthening to his people. Blessed is God.

Chapter 68

1 For the end, concerning those who will be changed; for Dauid.

2 Save me, God, because waters entered as far as my soul.

3 I became stuck in the mud of the deep, and there is no firm footing; I came into the depths of the sea, and a storm drowned me.

4 I grew weary crying out; my throat became hoarse; my eyes failed from hoping in my God.

5 Those hating me without cause were multiplied beyond the hairs of my head; my enemies, those pursuing me unjustly, grew strong; what I did not seize, then I repaid.

6 God, you knew my folly, and my transgressions were not hidden from you.

7 May those waiting for you not be put to shame because of me, Lord, Lord of powers; may those seeking you not be disgraced because of me, God of Israel,

8 because for your sake I endured reproach; disgrace covered my face.

9 I became estranged from my brothers and a stranger to the sons of my mother,

10 because zeal for your house devoured me, and the reproaches of those reproaching you fell upon me.

11 And I bent down my soul in fasting, and it became a reproach to me;

12 and I made sackcloth my clothing, and I became a parable to them.

13 Those sitting at the gate talked against me, and those drinking wine sang about me.

14 But I, with my prayer, am toward you, Lord; a time of good pleasure, God, in the multitude of your mercy; hear me in the truth of your salvation.

15 Save me from mud, so that I may not become stuck; may I be delivered from those hating me and from the depth of the waters;

16 let a storm of water not drown me, nor let the deep swallow me, nor let a well close its mouth over me.

17 Hear me, Lord, because your mercy is good; according to the multitude of your compassions look upon me.

18 Do not turn your face away from your servant, because I am afflicted; hear me quickly.

19 Attend to my soul and redeem it; because of my enemies deliver me.

20 For you know my reproach and my shame and my disgrace; all those afflicting me are before you.

21 My soul expected reproach and misery, and I waited for one grieving with me, and there was none, and for those comforting, and I found none.

22 And they gave gall for my food, and for my thirst they gave me vinegar to drink.

23 Let their table before them become a trap and a repayment and a stumbling block;

24 let their eyes be darkened so as not to see, and bend their back continually;

25 pour out your wrath upon them, and may the fury of your wrath overtake them.

26 Let their homestead become deserted, and let there be no one dwelling in their dwellings;

27 because the one you struck, they pursued, and they added to the pain of your wounded ones.

28 Add lawlessness to their lawlessness, and let them not enter into your righteousness;

29 let them be blotted out of the book of the living, and let them not be written with righteous ones.

30 I am poor and in pain, and the salvation of your face, God, took hold of me.

31 I will praise the name of God with a song; I will magnify him with praise,

32 and it will please God more than a young calf bringing forth horns and hoofs.

33 Let poor ones see and rejoice; seek out God, and your soul will live,

34 because the Lord heard the needy and did not despise his fettered ones.

35 Let the heavens and the earth praise him, the sea and all things creeping in them.

36 Because God will save Sion, and the cities of Ioudaia will be built, and they will dwell there and inherit it;

37 and the seed of his slaves will possess it, and those loving his name will dwell in it.

Chapter 69

1 For the end; for Dauid, for remembrance,

2 for the Lord to save me. God, attend to my help.

3 May those seeking my soul be ashamed and disgraced; may those wishing me evils turn backward and be put to shame;

4 may those saying to me: Well done, well done, turn back immediately in shame.

5 Let all those seeking you exult and rejoice in you, and let those loving your salvation say continually: Let God be magnified.

6 But I am poor and needy; God, help me. You are my helper and my deliverer; Lord, do not delay.

Chapter 70

1 For Dauid; of the sons of Ionadab and of those first taken captive. God, in you I hoped; may I not be put to shame forever.

2 In your righteousness deliver me and rescue me; incline your ear toward me and save me.

3 Become for me a defending God and a strong place to save me, because you are my firmness and my refuge.

4 My God, deliver me from a sinner's hand, from the hand of one acting lawlessly and unjustly;

5 because you are my endurance, Lord; the Lord is my hope from my youth.

6 Upon you I was supported from the belly; from my mother's womb you are my shelterer; in you is my hymn continually.

7 I became like a portent to the many, and you are a mighty helper.

8 Let my mouth be filled with praise, so that I may sing of your glory, all day of your magnificence.

9 Do not cast me away at a time of old age; when my strength fails, do not abandon me.

10 Because my enemies spoke to me, and those watching my soul planned together,

11 saying: God abandoned him; pursue and overtake him, because there is no one delivering.

12 God, do not go far from me; my God, attend to my help.

13 Let those slandering my soul be ashamed and fail; let those seeking evils for me clothe themselves in shame and disgrace.

14 But I will hope continually and add to all your praise.

15 My mouth will declare your righteousness, all day your salvation, because I did not know writings.

16 I will enter in the might of the Lord; Lord, I will remember your righteousness alone.

17 You taught me, God, from my youth, and until now I will report your wonders.

18 And until old age and advanced years, God, do not abandon me, until I report your arm to every coming generation, your might and your righteousness.

19 God, as far as the highest places, the great things you did; God, who is like you?

20 How many afflictions, many and evil, you showed me, and turning back, you gave me life, and from the abysses of the earth you brought me up again.

21 You increased your greatness, and turning back, you comforted me [and from the abysses of the earth you brought me up again.]

22 For indeed I will acknowledge your truth to you with an instrument of music, God; I will sing to you with a lyre, Holy One of Israel.

23 My lips will exult when I sing to you, and my soul, which you redeemed.

24 And moreover my tongue will meditate upon your righteousness all day, when those seeking evils for me are ashamed and disgraced.

Chapter 71

1 For Salomon. God, give your judgment to the king and your righteousness to the king's son,

2 to judge your people in righteousness and your poor ones in judgment.

3 Let the mountains take up peace for your people, and the hills in righteousness.

4 He will judge the poor of the people and save the sons of the needy and humble a false accuser,

5 and he will remain with the sun and before the moon for generations of generations,

6 and he will descend like rain upon a fleece and like drops dripping upon the earth.

7 Righteousness will rise in his days, and a multitude of peace, until the moon is taken away.

8 And he will rule from sea to sea and from a river to the ends of the inhabited world.

9 Before him Ethiopians will fall down, and his enemies will lick dust;

10 kings of Tharsis and the islands will offer gifts; kings of Arabs and Saba will bring gifts;

11 and all kings will bow to him; all nations will serve him.

12 Because he delivered a poor one from the hand of a powerful one, and a needy one who had no helper;

13 he will spare a poor and needy one and save the souls of the needy;

14 from interest and from injustice he will redeem their souls, and their name is honored before him.

15 And he will live, and some of the gold of Arabia will be given to him, and they will pray concerning him continually; all day they will bless him.

16 There will be support in the land upon the tops of the mountains; his fruit will be exalted beyond Libanos, and they will blossom out of a city like grass of the earth.

17 Let his name be blessed for the ages; before the sun his name will remain; and all the tribes of the earth will be blessed in him; all nations will call him blessed.

18 Blessed is the Lord God, the God of Israel, who alone does wonders,

19 and blessed is the name of his glory forever and for the age of the age, and all the earth will be filled with his glory. May it be, may it be.

20 The hymns of Dauid the son of Iessai ended. – –

Chapter 72

1 A psalm for Asaph. How good God is to Israel, to the upright in heart.

2 But my feet were nearly shaken; my steps almost poured away.

3 Because I envied the lawless, seeing the peace of sinners,

4 because there is no refusal at their death, and firmness in their scourge;

5 they are not in the toils of humans, and with humans they will not be scourged.

6 For this reason arrogance seized them; they clothed themselves with their injustice and impiety.

7 Their injustice will come out as from fat; they passed into a disposition of heart;

8 they thought and spoke in wickedness; they spoke injustice on high;

9 they set their mouth toward heaven, and their tongue passed over the earth.

10 For this reason my people will return here, and full days will be found for them.

11 And they said: How did God know, and is there knowledge in the Most High?

12 Behold, these are sinners and prosper; forever they possessed wealth.

13 And I said: Then in vain I made my heart righteous and washed my hands among innocent ones;

14 and I became scourged all day, and my reproof was in the mornings.

15 If I said: I will recount thus, behold, I have broken faith with the generation of your sons.

16 And I undertook to know this; it is toil before me,

17 until I enter the sanctuary of God and understand their last things.

18 But because of their deceits you set things for them; you cast them down when they were exalted.

19 How they became a desolation suddenly; they failed, they perished because of their lawlessness.

20 Like a dream of one waking, Lord, in your city you will despise their image.

21 Because my heart was inflamed, and my kidneys were changed,

22 and I was brought to nothing and did not know; I became beastlike before you.

23 And I am continually with you; you grasped my right hand;

24 with your counsel you guided me, and with glory you took me to yourself.

25 For what do I have in heaven, and from you what did I desire upon the earth?

26 My heart and my flesh failed; God is the God of my heart and my portion forever.

27 Because, behold, those distancing themselves from you will perish; you destroyed everyone prostituting himself away from you.

28 But for me, to cling to God is good, to place my hope in the Lord, to declare all your praises in the gates of the daughter of Sion.

Chapter 73

1 Of understanding, for Asaph. Why did you reject us to the end, God; why was your fury angry against the sheep of your pasture?

2 Remember your assembly, which you acquired from the beginning; you redeemed the rod of your inheritance, this Mount Sion in which you dwelt.

3 Lift your hands against their arrogances to the end, all the evils the enemy worked in your holy places.

4 And those hating you boasted in the midst of your feast; they set their signs as signs and did not know.

5 As at the entrance above,

6 as in a forest of trees, with axes they cut out her doors; together with axe and chisel they broke her down.

7 They burned your sanctuary with fire; to the ground they profaned the dwelling of your name.

8 Their kinship together said in their heart: Come, and let us burn all the feasts of God from the earth.

9 We did not see our signs; there is no longer a prophet, and he will no longer know us.

10 Until when, God, will the enemy reproach; will the adversary provoke your name to the end?

11 Why do you turn away your hand and your right hand from the midst of your bosom to the end?

12 But God is our king before the age; he worked salvation in the midst of the earth.

13 You strengthened the sea by your power; you shattered the heads of the dragons upon the water.

14 You crushed the heads of the dragon; you gave him as food to the Ethiopian peoples.

15 You broke open springs and torrents; you dried up rivers of Etham.

16 The day is yours, and the night is yours; you established light and sun.

17 You made all the boundaries of the earth; summer and spring, you formed them.

18 Remember this: an enemy reproached the Lord, and a foolish people provoked your name.

19 Do not hand over to the wild beasts a soul acknowledging you; do not forget the souls of your needy ones to the end.

20 Look upon your covenant, because the darkened places of the earth were filled with houses of lawless deeds.

21 Let a humbled one not turn back ashamed; a poor and needy one will praise your name.

22 Arise, God; judge your case; remember your reproaches from a fool all day.

23 Do not forget the voice of your suppliants; the arrogance of those hating you went up to you continually.

Chapter 74

1 For the end; do not destroy; a psalm of a song for Asaph.

2 We will acknowledge you, God; we will acknowledge and call upon your name.

3 I will recount all your wonders when I receive a time; I will judge upright things.

4 The earth melted, and all those dwelling in it; I made its pillars firm. Interlude.

5 I said to those acting lawlessly: Do not act lawlessly; and to those sinning: Do not exalt a horn;

6 do not lift your horn on high; do not speak injustice against God.

7 Because neither from departures nor from the west nor from deserted mountains,

8 because God is judge; he humbles this one and exalts this one.

9 Because a cup is in the Lord's hand, of unmixed wine, full of a mixture, and he tipped from this into this; but its dregs were not emptied out; all the sinners of the earth will drink.

10 But I will exult forever; I will sing to the God of Iakob;

11 and I will break all the horns of sinners, and the horns of the righteous one will be exalted.

Chapter 75

1 For the end, in hymns; a psalm for Asaph, a song against the Assyrian.

2 God is known in Ioudaia; in Israel his name is great.

3 And his place came to be in peace, and his dwelling in Sion;

4 there he shattered the powers of bows, weapon and sword and war. Interlude.

5 You give light marvelously from everlasting mountains.

6 All those senseless in heart were troubled; they slept their sleep, and all the men of wealth found nothing with their hands.

7 At your rebuke, God of Iakob, those mounted on horses slumbered.

8 You are fearsome, and who will withstand you? From then is your wrath.

9 From heaven you made judgment heard; the earth was afraid and quiet

10 when God arose for judgment, to save all the meek of the earth. Interlude.

11 Because a human's thought will acknowledge you, and a remnant of thought will keep a feast for you.

12 Make vows and pay them to the Lord your God; all those around him will bring gifts

13 to the fearsome one who takes away spirits of rulers, fearsome among the kings of the earth.

Chapter 76

1 For the end, concerning Idithoun; for Asaph, a psalm.

2 With my voice I cried out to the Lord, with my voice to God, and he attended to me.

3 On the day of my affliction I sought out God, with my hands at night before him, and I was not deceived; my soul refused to be comforted.

4 I remembered God and rejoiced; I meditated, and my spirit grew fainthearted. Interlude.

5 My eyes anticipated watches; I was troubled and did not speak.

6 I considered ancient days, and I remembered everlasting years and meditated;

7 at night I meditated with my heart, and my spirit searched.

8 Surely the Lord will not reject for the ages and no longer continue to take pleasure?

9 Or will he cut off his mercy to the end, from generation to generation?

10 Or will God forget to pity, or will he restrain his compassions in his wrath? Interlude.

11 And I said: Now I began; this is the change of the right hand of the Most High.

12 I remembered the works of the Lord, because I will remember your wonders from the beginning,

13 and I will meditate on all your works, and on your practices I will ponder.

14 God, your way is in the holy place; what god is great like our God?

15 You are the God doing wonders; you made your strength known among the peoples;

16 with your arm you redeemed your people, the sons of Iakob and Ioseph. Interlude.

17 Waters saw you, God; waters saw you and were afraid, and abysses were troubled, a multitude of the sound of waters.

18 The clouds gave a voice, for indeed your arrows pass through;

19 the voice of your thunder is in the wheel; your lightnings shone upon the inhabited world; the earth was shaken and became trembling.

20 Your way is in the sea, and your paths in many waters, and your tracks will not be known.

21 You guided your people like sheep by the hand of Moyses and Aaron.

Chapter 77

1 Of understanding, for Asaph. Attend to my law, my people; incline your ear to the words of my mouth;

2 I will open my mouth in parables; I will utter riddles from the beginning.

3 All that we heard and knew, and our fathers recounted to us,

4 was not hidden from their children, to another generation, reporting the praises of the Lord and his mighty deeds and his wonders which he did.

5 And he raised up a testimony in Iakob and established a law in Israel, all that he commanded our fathers to make known to their sons,

6 so that another generation might know, sons who will be born, and they will arise and report them to their sons,

7 so that they may place their hope upon God and not forget the works of God, and they will seek out his commandments,

8 so that they may not become like their fathers, a crooked generation provoking bitterness, a generation that did not direct its heart, and its spirit was not faithful with God.

9 Sons of Ephraim, drawing and shooting with bows, turned back on a day of war.

10 They did not keep the covenant of God and did not wish to walk in his law,

11 and they forgot his benefits and his wonders which he showed them,

12 the wonders he did before their fathers in the land of Egypt, in the plain of Tanis.

13 He broke open a sea and led them through; he made waters stand like a wineskin,

14 and he guided them with a cloud by day and all night with illumination of fire.

15 He broke open a rock in a wilderness and gave them drink as in a great abyss,

16 and brought water out of a rock and brought waters down like rivers.

17 And they continued still to sin against him; they provoked the Most High to bitterness in a waterless place,

18 and they tested God in their hearts by asking foods for their souls,

19 and they spoke against God and said: Surely God cannot prepare a table in a wilderness?

20 Since he struck a rock and waters flowed and torrents flooded, can he also give bread or prepare a table for his people?

21 For this reason the Lord heard and deferred, and fire was kindled in Iakob, and wrath rose against Israel,

22 because they did not believe in God or hope in his salvation.

23 And he commanded clouds above and opened doors of heaven,

24 and rained manna upon them to eat, and gave them bread of heaven;

25 a human ate bread of angels; he sent them provisions to fullness.

26 He moved a south wind from heaven and brought a southwest wind by his might,

27 and rained flesh upon them like dust, and winged birds like sand of seas,

28 and they fell into the midst of their camp, around their dwellings,

29 and they ate and were greatly filled, and he brought their desire to them;

30 they were not deprived of their desire. While their food was still in their mouth,

31 the wrath of God also rose against them and killed among their fat ones and fettered the chosen ones of Israel.

32 In all these things they still sinned and did not believe in his wonders,

33 and their days failed in vanity, and their years with haste.

34 When he killed them, they sought him out and turned back and rose early toward God,

35 and remembered that God is their helper and God Most High is their redeemer.

36 And they deceived him with their mouth and lied to him with their tongue,

37 but their heart was not upright with him, nor were they faithful in his covenant.

38 But he is compassionate and will atone for their sins and will not destroy, and will multiply the turning away of his fury, and will not kindle all his wrath;

39 and he remembered that they are flesh, a spirit going and not returning.

40 How often did they provoke him to bitterness in the wilderness, anger him in a waterless land?

41 And they turned back and tested God and provoked the Holy One of Israel.

42 They did not remember his hand, the day on which he redeemed them from the hand of an afflicter,

43 how he established his signs in Egypt and his portents in the plain of Tanis;

44 and he turned their rivers and their rainwaters into blood, so that they might not drink;

45 he sent a dog-fly against them, and it devoured them, and a frog, and it destroyed them;

46 and he gave their fruit to rust and their labors to the locust;

47 he killed their vine with hail and their mulberry trees with frost;

48 and he handed their beasts over to hail and their possessions to fire;

49 he sent upon them the wrath of his fury, fury and wrath and affliction, a sending through evil angels;

50 he made a road for his wrath; he did not spare their souls from death, and he shut up their beasts to death,

51 and struck every firstborn in Egypt, the firstfruits of their labors in the dwellings of Cham.

52 And he moved his people like sheep and led them up like a flock in a wilderness,

53 and guided them in hope, and they were not afraid, and a sea covered their enemies.

54 And he brought them into the boundary of his sanctuary, this mountain which his right hand acquired,

55 and cast nations out from before their face and allotted them with a measuring cord of inheritance, and settled the tribes of Israel in their dwellings.

56 And they tested and provoked God Most High to bitterness, and did not keep his testimonies,

57 and turned away and broke faith, just as their fathers also did, and were turned into a crooked bow,

58 and angered him with their hills and provoked him to jealousy with their carved things.

59 God heard and overlooked and greatly despised Israel,

60 and rejected the tent of Selom, his dwelling where he dwelt among humans.

61 And he handed their strength over to captivity and their beauty into an enemy's hands,

62 and shut up his people to a sword and overlooked his inheritance.

63 Fire devoured their young men, and their virgins were not mourned;

64 their priests fell by a sword, and their widows will not be wept for.

65 And the Lord awoke like one sleeping, like a mighty one intoxicated with wine,

66 and struck his enemies backward; he gave them everlasting reproach.

67 And he rejected the dwelling of Ioseph and did not choose the tribe of Ephraim;

68 and he chose the tribe of Iouda, Mount Sion which he loved,

69 and built his sanctuary like that of one-horned beasts; in the earth he founded it forever.

70 And he chose Dauid his slave and took him up from the flocks of sheep;

71 from behind those giving birth he took him to shepherd Iakob his people and Israel his inheritance,

72 and he shepherded them in the innocence of his heart and guided them with the understandings of his hands.

Chapter 78

1 A psalm for Asaph. God, nations came into your inheritance; they defiled your holy temple; they made Ierousalem into a fruit-watch hut.

2 They made the corpses of your slaves food for the birds of heaven, the flesh of your holy ones for the wild beasts of the earth;

3 they poured out their blood like water around Ierousalem, and there was no one burying.

4 We became a reproach to our neighbors, a sneer and mockery to those around us.

5 Until when, Lord, will you be angry to the end; will your jealousy be kindled like fire?

6 Pour out your wrath upon nations that do not know you and upon kingdoms that did not call upon your name,

7 because they devoured Iakob and deserted his place.

8 Do not remember our ancient lawless deeds; let your compassions quickly anticipate us, because we became very poor.

9 Help us, God our savior; because of the glory of your name, Lord, deliver us and atone for our sins because of your name,

10 lest the nations say: Where is their God? And let the vengeance for the poured-out blood of your slaves be known among the nations before our eyes.

11 Let the groaning of those fettered enter before you; according to the greatness of your arm preserve the sons of those put to death.

12 Repay our neighbors sevenfold into their bosom their reproach with which they reproached you, Lord.

13 But we, your people and sheep of your pasture, will acknowledge you forever; to generation and generation we will declare your praise.

Chapter 79

1 For the end, concerning those who will be changed; a testimony for Asaph, a psalm concerning the Assyrian.

2 You who shepherd Israel, attend; you who guide Ioseph like sheep, you who sit upon the cheroubin, appear.

3 Before Ephraim and Beniamin and Manasse awaken your might and come to save us.

4 God, turn us back and make your face shine, and we will be saved.

5 Lord, God of powers, until when are you angry against the prayer of your slave,

6 will you feed us bread of tears and give us tears to drink in measure?

7 You made us a contradiction to our neighbors, and our enemies sneered at us.

8 Lord, God of powers, turn us back and make your face shine, and we will be saved. Interlude.

9 You removed a vine from Egypt; you cast out nations and planted it;

10 you made a road before it and planted its roots, and the earth was filled.

11 Its shadow covered mountains, and its climbing branches the cedars of God;

12 it extended its shoots as far as a sea, and its offshoots as far as a river.

13 Why did you pull down its fence, and all those passing along the road harvest it?

14 A boar from a forest ravaged it, and a solitary wild beast grazed it down.

15 God of powers, turn back, then; look from heaven and see and visit this vine,

16 and restore it, which your right hand planted, and upon a son of a human whom you strengthened for yourself.

17 Burned with fire and dug up; at the rebuke of your face they will perish.

18 Let your hand be upon a man of your right hand and upon a son of a human whom you strengthened for yourself;

19 and we will certainly not depart from you; you will give us life, and we will call upon your name.

20 Lord, God of powers, turn us back and make your face shine, and we will be saved.

Chapter 80

1 For the end, concerning the winepresses; for Asaph, a psalm.

2 Exult in God our helper; shout to the God of Iakob;

3 take up a psalm and give a tambourine, a delightful psaltery with a lyre;

4 blow a trumpet at the new moon, on the marked day of our feast;

5 because it is an ordinance for Israel and a judgment for the God of Iakob.

6 He established it as a testimony in Ioseph when he went out from the land of Egypt; he heard a tongue that he did not know;

7 he removed his back from burdens; his hands served in the basket.

8 In affliction you called upon me, and I delivered you; I heard you in the hidden place of a storm; I tested you at water of contradiction. Interlude.

9 Hear, my people, and I testify to you; Israel, if you hear me,

10 there will be no new god among you, nor will you bow to a foreign god;

11 for I am the Lord your God who brought you up from the land of Egypt; widen your mouth, and I will fill it.

12 And my people did not hear my voice, and Israel did not attend to me;

13 and I sent them away according to the practices of their hearts; they will walk in their practices.

14 If my people had heard me, if Israel had walked in my ways,

15 in no time I would have humbled their enemies and laid my hand upon those afflicting them.

16 The enemies of the Lord lied to him, and their time will be forever.

17 And he fed them from the fat of wheat and filled them with honey from a rock.

Chapter 81

1 A psalm for Asaph. God stood in an assembly of gods, and in the midst he judges gods:

2 Until when do you judge injustice and accept faces of sinners? Interlude.

3 Judge an orphan and a poor one; justify a humbled and needy one;

4 rescue a needy and poor one; deliver from a sinner's hand.

5 They did not know or understand; they walk in darkness; all the foundations of the earth will be shaken.

6 I said: You are gods and all sons of the Most High;

7 but you die like humans and fall like one of the rulers.

8 Arise, God; judge the earth, because you will inherit among all the nations.

Chapter 82

1 A song of a psalm for Asaph.

2 God, who will be likened to you? Do not be silent or grow calm, God;

3 because, behold, your enemies made a noise, and those hating you lifted a head;

4 against your people they cunningly devised a plan, and they counseled against your holy ones;

5 they said: Come, and let us destroy them from being a nation, and the name of Israel will certainly no longer be remembered.

6 Because they counseled together in concord; they made a covenant against you,

7 the dwellings of the Idumaians and the Ismaelites, Moab and the Agarenes,

8 Gebal and Ammon and Amalek and foreigners with those inhabiting Tyros;

9 for indeed Assour also joined them; they became a support to the sons of Lot. Interlude.

10 Do to them as to Madiam and Sisara, as Iabin at the torrent Kison;

11 they were destroyed in Aendor; they became like dung for the earth.

12 Make their rulers like Oreb and Zeb and Zebee and Salmana, all their rulers,

13 who said: Let us inherit the sanctuary of God for ourselves.

14 My God, make them like a wheel, like straw before the face of wind;

15 like fire which will burn through a forest, as though a flame might burn mountains,

16 thus you will pursue them with your storm and trouble them with your wrath.

17 Fill their faces with dishonor, and they will seek your name, Lord.

18 Let them be ashamed and troubled for the age of the age, and let them be disgraced and perish,

19 and let them know that your name is Lord; you alone are Most High over all the earth.

Chapter 83

1 For the end, concerning the winepresses; for the sons of Kore, a psalm.

2 How beloved are your dwellings, Lord of powers.

3 My soul longs and fails for the courts of the Lord; my heart and my flesh exulted in the living God.

4 For indeed a sparrow found itself a house, and a turtledove a nest for herself, where she will put her young, your altars, Lord of powers, my king and my God.

5 Blessed are those dwelling in your house; for the ages of the ages they will praise you. Interlude.

6 Blessed is a man whose support is from you, Lord; he arranged ascents in his heart

7 in the valley of weeping, to the place he established; for indeed the lawgiver will give blessings.

8 They will go from strength to strength; the God of gods will appear in Sion.

9 Lord, God of powers, hear my prayer; give ear, God of Iakob. Interlude.

10 Our defender, see, God, and look upon the face of your anointed one.

11 Because one day in your courts is better than thousands; I chose to be cast aside in the house of God rather than dwell in dwellings of sinners.

12 Because the Lord God loves mercy and truth; he will give grace and glory; the Lord will not deprive those walking in innocence of good things.

13 Lord of powers, blessed is the human hoping in you.

Chapter 84

1 For the end; for the sons of Kore, a psalm.

2 You took pleasure in your land, Lord; you turned back the captivity of Iakob;

3 you forgave the lawless deeds of your people; you covered all their sins. Interlude.

4 You stopped all your wrath; you turned away from the wrath of your fury.

5 Turn us back, God of our salvations, and turn your fury away from us.

6 Surely you will not be angry with us forever, or extend your wrath from generation to generation?

7 God, turning back, you will give us life, and your people will rejoice in you.

8 Show us your mercy, Lord, and may you give us your salvation.

9 I will hear what the Lord God will speak within me, because he will speak peace upon his people and upon his holy ones and upon those turning their heart toward him.

10 But his salvation is near those fearing him, that glory may dwell in our land.

11 Mercy and truth met; righteousness and peace kissed;

12 truth rose from the earth, and righteousness leaned down from heaven.

13 For indeed the Lord will give goodness, and our land will give its fruit;

14 righteousness will go before him and set his steps upon a way.

Chapter 85

1 A prayer for Dauid. Incline your ear, Lord, and hear me, because I am poor and needy.

2 Guard my soul, because I am holy; save your slave, my God, the one hoping in you.

3 Have mercy on me, Lord, because I will cry out to you all day.

4 Gladden the soul of your slave, because toward you, Lord, I lifted my soul.

5 Because you, Lord, are good and gentle and abundant in mercy to all those calling upon you.

6 Give ear, Lord, to my prayer, and attend to the voice of my supplication.

7 On the day of my affliction I cried out to you, because you heard me.

8 There is none like you among gods, Lord, and there is nothing according to your works.

9 All the nations that you made will come and bow before you, Lord, and glorify your name,

10 because you are great and do wonders; you alone are the great God.

11 Guide me, Lord, in your way, and I will walk in your truth; let my heart rejoice to fear your name.

12 I will acknowledge you, Lord my God, with my whole heart, and glorify your name forever,

13 because your mercy is great upon me, and you delivered my soul from the lowest Hades.

14 God, lawless ones rose against me, and an assembly of mighty ones sought my soul and did not set you before them.

15 And you, Lord God, are compassionate and merciful, patient and abundant in mercy and true.

16 Look upon me and have mercy on me; give your strength to your servant and save the son of your maidservant.

17 Make with me a sign for good, and let those hating me see and be ashamed, because you, Lord, helped me and comforted me.

Chapter 86

1 For the sons of Kore, a psalm of a song. His foundations are in the holy mountains;

2 the Lord loves the gates of Sion more than all the dwellings of Iakob.

3 Glorious things were spoken concerning you, city of God. Interlude.

4 I will remember Raab and Babylon to those knowing me; and behold, foreigners and Tyros and a people of Ethiopians, these were born there.

5 Mother Sion, a human will say, and a human was born in her, and the Most High himself founded her.

6 The Lord will recount in a register of peoples and rulers these who have been born in her. Interlude.

7 As of all rejoicing, the dwelling is in you.

Chapter 87

1 A song of a psalm for the sons of Kore; for the end, concerning maeleth, to respond; of understanding, for Aiman the Israelite.

2 Lord, God of my salvation, by day I cried out and by night before you;

3 let my prayer enter before you; incline your ear to my supplication, Lord.

4 Because my soul was filled with evils, and my life drew near to Hades;

5 I was counted with those descending into a pit; I became like a human without help, free among the dead,

6 like wounded ones cast away, sleeping in a grave, whom you remembered no longer, and they were thrust away from your hand.

7 They placed me in a lowest pit, in dark places and in a shadow of death.

8 Your fury rested upon me, and you brought all your billows upon me. Interlude.

9 You distanced my acquaintances from me; they made me an abomination to themselves; I was handed over and did not go out.

10 My eyes grew weak from poverty; I cried out to you, Lord, all day; I spread out my hands toward you:

11 Surely you will not do wonders for the dead? Or will physicians raise them, and they will acknowledge you?

12 Surely someone will not recount your mercy in a grave and your truth in destruction?

13 Surely your wonders will not be known in the darkness, and your righteousness in a forgotten land?

14 And I cried out to you, Lord, and in the morning my prayer will go before you.

15 Why, Lord, do you thrust away my soul, turn your face away from me?

16 I am poor and in toils from my youth, but having been exalted, I was humbled and utterly at a loss.

17 Your wraths passed over me, and your terrors greatly troubled me;

18 they circled me like water all day; they encompassed me together.

19 You distanced friend and neighbor from me, and my acquaintances from misery.

Chapter 88

1 Of understanding, for Aithan the Israelite.

2 Your mercies, Lord, I will sing forever; to generation and generation I will report your truth with my mouth,

3 because you said: Forever mercy will be built; in the heavens your truth will be prepared.

4 I made a covenant with my chosen ones; I swore to Dauid my slave:

5 Forever I will prepare your seed and build your throne to generation and generation. Interlude.

6 The heavens will acknowledge your wonders, Lord, and your truth in an assembly of holy ones.

7 Because who in clouds will be equal to the Lord, and who among sons of God will be likened to the Lord?

8 God is glorified in a council of holy ones, great and fearsome over all those around him.

9 Lord, God of powers, who is like you? You are mighty, Lord, and your truth is around you.

10 You rule the strength of the sea, and you calm the tossing of its waves.

11 You humbled a proud one like a wounded one, and with the arm of your strength you scattered your enemies.

12 The heavens are yours, and the earth is yours; you founded the inhabited world and its fullness.

13 You created the north and seas; Thabor and Ermon will exult in your name.

14 Yours is the arm with might; let your hand be strengthened; let your right hand be exalted.

15 Righteousness and judgment are the preparation of your throne; mercy and truth will go before your face.

16 Blessed is the people knowing a shout; Lord, they will walk in the light of your face,

17 and exult in your name all day, and be exalted in your righteousness.

18 Because you are the boast of their strength, and in your good pleasure our horn will be exalted.

19 Because support belongs to the Lord, and to the Holy One of Israel, our king.

20 Then you spoke in a vision to your holy ones and said: I placed help upon a mighty one; I exalted a chosen one from my people;

21 I found Dauid my slave; with my holy oil I anointed him.

22 For my hand will support him, and my arm will strengthen him;

23 an enemy will not gain advantage over him, and a son of lawlessness will not continue to harm him;

24 and I will cut down his enemies from before his face and rout those hating him.

25 And my truth and my mercy are with him, and in my name his horn will be exalted;

26 and I will place his hand in a sea and his right hand in rivers.

27 He will call upon me: You are my father, my God and supporter of my salvation;

28 and I will make him firstborn, high among the kings of the earth.

29 Forever I will keep my mercy for him, and my covenant is faithful to him;

30 and I will establish his seed for the age of the age, and his throne like the days of heaven.

31 If his sons abandon my law and do not walk in my judgments,

32 if they profane my ordinances and do not keep my commandments,

33 I will visit their lawless deeds with a rod and their sins with scourges,

34 but I will certainly not scatter my mercy away from him, nor will I act unjustly in my truth,

35 nor will I profane my covenant, and I will certainly not reject the things proceeding through my lips.

36 Once I swore in my holy place: If I lie to Dauid—

37 His seed will remain forever, and his throne like the sun before me,

38 and like the moon established forever; and the witness in heaven is faithful. Interlude.

39 But you rejected and despised; you put off your anointed one;

40 you overturned the covenant of your slave; you profaned his sanctuary to the ground.

41 You pulled down all his fences; you made his fortifications a terror;

42 all those traveling a road plundered him; he became a reproach to his neighbors.

43 You exalted the right hand of his enemies; you gladdened all his enemies;

44 you turned away the help of his sword and did not support him in the war.

45 You removed him from purification; you broke his throne down to the ground;

46 you shortened the days of his time; you poured shame upon him. Interlude.

47 Until when, Lord, will you turn away to the end; will your wrath be kindled like fire?

48 Remember what my existence is; for surely you did not create all the sons of humans in vain?

49 Who is a human who will live and not see death, who will deliver his soul from the hand of Hades? Interlude.

50 Where are your ancient mercies, Lord, which you swore to Dauid in your truth?

51 Remember, Lord, the reproach of your slaves, which I bore in my bosom, of many nations,

52 with which your enemies reproached, Lord, with which they reproached the exchange of your anointed one.

53 Blessed is the Lord forever. May it be, may it be. – –

Chapter 89

1 A prayer of Moyses, a human of God. Lord, you became a refuge for us in generation and generation;

2 before mountains came to be and the earth and inhabited world were formed, and from the age to the age, you are.

3 Do not turn a human back to humiliation; and you said: Turn back, sons of humans.

4 Because a thousand years in your eyes are like yesterday's day which passed, and a watch in the night.

5 Their things of no account will be years. In the morning may he pass away like green grass,

6 in the morning may he blossom and pass away, in the evening may he fall off, grow hard and dry.

7 Because we failed in your wrath and were troubled in your fury.

8 You placed our lawless deeds before you; our lifetime is in the illumination of your face.

9 Because all our days failed, and in your wrath we failed; they pondered our years like a spider.

10 The days of our years, in them are seventy years, but if in strength, eighty years, and most of them toil and pain; because gentleness came upon us, and we will be disciplined.

11 Who knows the strength of your wrath, and from fear of you, your fury?

12 Thus make known how to number your right hand, and those fettered in heart in wisdom.

13 Turn back, Lord; until when? And be comforted concerning your slaves.

14 We were filled in the morning with your mercy and exulted and rejoiced in all our days;

15 we rejoiced in return for the days in which you humbled us, the years in which we saw evils.

16 And look upon your slaves and your works, and guide their sons,

17 and let the splendor of the Lord our God be upon us, and direct the works of our hands upon us.

Chapter 90

1 Praise of a song for Dauid. The one dwelling in the help of the Most High will lodge in the shelter of the God of heaven.

2 He will say to the Lord: You are my supporter and my refuge, my God; I will hope in him,

3 because he will deliver me from a trap of hunters and from a troubling word.

4 With his back he will overshadow you, and beneath his wings you will hope; his truth will encircle you with a weapon.

5 You will not be afraid of a fear by night, of an arrow flying by day,

6 of a thing passing through in darkness, of calamity and a midday demon.

7 A thousand will fall from your side and ten thousand from your right, but it will not approach you;

8 but with your eyes you will perceive and see the repayment of sinners.

9 Because you, Lord, are my hope; you made the Most High your refuge.

10 Evils will not approach you, and a scourge will not approach your dwelling,

11 because he will command his angels concerning you, to guard you in all your ways;

12 upon hands they will lift you, lest you strike your foot against a stone;

13 upon an asp and a basilisk you will step, and you will trample a lion and a dragon.

14 Because he hoped in me, I will also deliver him; I will shelter him, because he knew my name.

15 He will call upon me, and I will hear him; I am with him in affliction, and I will deliver and glorify him.

16 I will fill him with length of days and show him my salvation.

Chapter 91

1 A psalm of a song, for the day of the sabbath.

2 It is good to acknowledge the Lord and sing to your name, Most High,

3 to announce your mercy in the morning and your truth by night,

4 with a ten-stringed psaltery, with a song on a lyre.

5 Because you gladdened me, Lord, with your deed, and in the works of your hands I will exult.

6 How your works were magnified, Lord; your reasonings became very deep.

7 A foolish man will not know, and a senseless one will not understand these things.

8 When sinners sprouted like grass, and all those working lawlessness leaned down, so that they might be destroyed for the age of the age.

9 But you are Most High forever, Lord;

10 because, behold, your enemies will perish, and all those working lawlessness will be scattered,

11 and my horn will be exalted like that of a one-horned beast, and my old age in rich oil,

12 and my eye looked upon my enemies, and my ear will hear among those rising against me, doing evil.

13 A righteous one will blossom like a palm; like the cedar in Libanos he will multiply.

14 Planted in the house of the Lord, they will blossom in the courts of our God;

15 they will still multiply in rich old age and will be flourishing,

16 to announce that the Lord my God is upright and there is no injustice in him.

Chapter 92

1 For the day before the sabbath, when the earth has been settled; praise of a song for Dauid. The Lord reigned; he clothed himself with magnificence; the Lord clothed himself with strength and girded himself; for indeed he made the inhabited world firm, which will not be shaken.

2 Your throne is ready from then; you are from the age.

3 The rivers lifted up, Lord; the rivers lifted up their voices;

4 from the voices of many waters the billows of the sea are marvelous; marvelous in the heights is the Lord.

5 Your testimonies were made very faithful; holiness befits your house, Lord, for length of days.

Chapter 93

1 A psalm for Dauid, on the fourth day of the week. The God of vengeances is the Lord; the God of vengeances spoke boldly.

2 Be exalted, you who judge the earth; repay a repayment to the arrogant.

3 Until when will sinners, Lord, until when will sinners boast,

4 utter and speak injustice; will all those working lawlessness speak?

5 They humbled your people, Lord, and harmed your inheritance;

6 they killed a widow and a sojourner and murdered orphans,

7 and said: The Lord will not see, nor will the God of Iakob understand.

8 Understand, then, foolish ones among the people, and, fools, at last be sensible.

9 Does not the one planting the ear hear, or does the one forming the eye not perceive?

10 Will not the one disciplining nations reprove, the one teaching a human knowledge?

11 The Lord knows the reasonings of humans, that they are vain.

12 Blessed is a human whom you discipline, Lord, and teach from your law,

13 to give him calm from evil days, until a pit is dug for the sinner.

14 Because the Lord will not reject his people and will not abandon his inheritance,

15 until righteousness returns to judgment, and all the upright in heart follow it. Interlude.

16 Who will arise for me against those doing evil, or who will stand with me against those working lawlessness?

17 If the Lord had not helped me, my soul would soon have sojourned in Hades.

18 If I said: My foot has been shaken, your mercy, Lord, helps me;

19 Lord, according to the multitude of my pains in my heart, your comforts loved my soul.

20 Surely a throne of lawlessness will not be joined to you, the one forming toil by ordinance?

21 They will hunt against a righteous one's soul and condemn innocent blood.

22 And the Lord became a refuge for me, and my God a helper of my hope;

23 and he will repay them their lawlessness, and according to their wickedness the Lord our God will make them vanish.

Chapter 94

1 Praise of a song for Dauid. Come, let us exult in the Lord; let us shout to God our savior;

2 let us come before his face with acknowledgment and shout to him with psalms.

3 Because the Lord is a great God and a great king over all the gods;

4 because in his hand are the ends of the earth, and the heights of the mountains are his;

5 because the sea is his, and he made it, and his hands formed the dry land.

6 Come, let us bow and fall before him and weep before the Lord who made us;

7 because he is our God, and we are a people of his pasture and sheep of his hand. Today, if you hear his voice,

8 do not harden your hearts as in the provocation to bitterness, on the day of testing in the wilderness,

9 where your fathers tested, tried and saw my works.

10 Forty years I was vexed with that generation and said: They always stray in heart, and they did not know my ways,

11 as I swore in my wrath: They shall not enter my rest.

Chapter 95

1 When the house was being built after the captivity; a song for Dauid. Sing a new song to the Lord; sing to the Lord, all the earth;

2 sing to the Lord; bless his name; announce his salvation as good news day by day;

3 announce his glory among the nations, his wonders among all the peoples.

4 Because the Lord is great and greatly praiseworthy; he is fearsome over all the gods;

5 because all the gods of the nations are demons, but the Lord made the heavens;

6 acknowledgment and beauty are before him, holiness and magnificence in his sanctuary.

7 Bring to the Lord, families of the nations; bring to the Lord glory and honor;

8 bring to the Lord glory for his name; take up sacrifices and enter his courts;

9 bow to the Lord in his holy court; let all the earth be shaken before his face.

10 Say among the nations: The Lord reigned; for indeed he established the inhabited world, which will not be shaken; he will judge peoples in uprightness.

11 Let the heavens rejoice, and let the earth exult; let the sea and its fullness be shaken;

12 the plains and all the things in them will rejoice; then all the trees of the forest will exult

13 before the face of the Lord, because he comes, because he comes to judge the earth; he will judge the inhabited world in righteousness and peoples in his truth.

Chapter 96

1 For Dauid, when his land is being established. The Lord reigned; let the earth exult; let many islands rejoice.

2 Cloud and gloom are around him; righteousness and judgment are the establishment of his throne.

3 Fire will go before him and burn his enemies around him;

4 his lightnings shone upon the inhabited world; the earth saw and was shaken.

5 The mountains melted like wax before the face of the Lord, before the face of the Lord of all the earth.

6 The heavens announced his righteousness, and all the peoples saw his glory.

7 Let all those bowing to carved things, those boasting in their idols, be ashamed; bow to him, all his angels.

8 Sion heard and rejoiced, and the daughters of Ioudaia exulted because of your judgments, Lord;

9 because you are the Lord Most High over all the earth; you were greatly exalted above all the gods.

10 Those loving the Lord, hate evil; the Lord guards the souls of his holy ones; from the hand of sinners he will deliver them.

11 Light rose for the righteous one, and gladness for the upright in heart.

12 Rejoice in the Lord, righteous ones, and acknowledge the remembrance of his holiness.

Chapter 97

1 A psalm for Dauid. Sing a new song to the Lord, because the Lord did marvelous things; his right hand and his holy arm saved for him.

2 The Lord made his salvation known; before the nations he revealed his righteousness.

3 He remembered his mercy to Iakob and his truth to the house of Israel; all the ends of the earth saw the salvation of our God.

4 Shout to God, all the earth; sing and exult and make music;

5 sing to the Lord with a lyre, with a lyre and the voice of a psalm;

6 with beaten trumpets and the sound of a horn trumpet shout before the king, the Lord.

7 Let the sea and its fullness be shaken, the inhabited world and those dwelling in it;

8 rivers will clap a hand together; the mountains will exult,

9 because he comes to judge the earth; he will judge the inhabited world in righteousness and peoples in uprightness.

Chapter 98

1 A psalm for Dauid. The Lord reigned; let peoples be angry; the one sitting upon the cheroubin, let the earth be shaken.

2 The Lord is great in Sion and high over all the peoples;

3 let them acknowledge your great name, because it is fearsome and holy.

4 And a king's honor loves judgment; you prepared upright things; you worked judgment and righteousness in Iakob.

5 Exalt the Lord our God and bow to the footstool of his feet, because he is holy.

6 Moyses and Aaron among his priests, and Samouel among those calling upon his name; they called upon the Lord, and he heard them;

7 in a pillar of cloud he spoke to them; they kept his testimonies and the ordinances he gave them.

8 Lord our God, you heard them; God, you became gracious to them, and avenged all their practices.

9 Exalt the Lord our God and bow toward his holy mountain, because the Lord our God is holy.

Chapter 99

1 A psalm for acknowledgment. Shout to the Lord, all the earth;

2 serve the Lord in gladness; enter before him in exultation.

3 Know that the Lord, he is God; he made us, and not we, his people and sheep of his pasture.

4 Enter his gates with acknowledgment, his courts with hymns; acknowledge him; praise his name,

5 because the Lord is good, his mercy is forever, and his truth to generation and generation.

Chapter 100

1 For Dauid, a psalm. Mercy and judgment I will sing to you, Lord;

2 I will make music and understand in a blameless way; when will you come to me? I walked in the innocence of my heart in the midst of my house.

3 I did not set a lawless thing before my eyes; I hated those doing transgressions;

4 a crooked heart did not cling to me; when the evil one turned away from me, I did not know him.

5 The one secretly speaking against his neighbor, this one I pursued; one with an arrogant eye and an insatiable heart, with this one I did not eat.

6 My eyes were upon the faithful of the earth, that they might sit with me; one walking in a blameless way, this one ministered to me.

7 One practicing arrogance did not dwell in the midst of my house; one speaking unjust things did not prosper before my eyes.

8 In the mornings I killed all the sinners of the earth, to destroy from the city of the Lord all those working lawlessness.

Chapter 101

1 A prayer for the poor one when he grows weary and pours out his supplication before the Lord.

2 Hear my prayer, Lord, and let my cry come to you.

3 Do not turn your face away from me; on whatever day I am afflicted, incline your ear toward me; on whatever day I call upon you, hear me quickly.

4 Because my days failed like smoke, and my bones were roasted together like a roasting pan.

5 My heart was struck like grass and dried up, because I forgot to eat my bread.

6 From the voice of my groaning my bone clung to my flesh.

7 I was likened to a wilderness pelican; I became like a night raven on a house site;

8 I kept awake and became like a sparrow alone upon a roof.

9 All day my enemies reproached me, and those praising me swore against me.

10 Because I ate ashes like bread and mixed my drink with weeping,

11 before the face of your wrath and your fury, because, lifting me, you dashed me down.

12 My days declined like a shadow, and I dried up like grass.

13 But you, Lord, remain forever, and your remembrance to generation and generation.

14 You will arise and pity Sion, because it is time to pity her, because the time has come;

15 because your slaves took pleasure in her stones and will pity her dust.

16 And the nations will fear the name of the Lord, and all the kings of the earth your glory,

17 because the Lord will build Sion and appear in his glory.

18 He looked upon the prayer of the humble and did not despise their supplication.

19 Let this be written for another generation, and a people being created will praise the Lord,

20 because he leaned out from his holy height; the Lord looked from heaven upon the earth,

21 to hear the groaning of those fettered, to release the sons of those put to death,

22 to announce in Sion the name of the Lord and his praise in Ierousalem,

23 when peoples gather together, and kingdoms, to serve the Lord.

24 He answered him in the way of his strength: Announce to me the fewness of my days;

25 do not take me up halfway through my days; your years are in a generation of generations.

26 In the beginning you, Lord, founded the earth, and the heavens are works of your hands;

27 they will perish, but you will remain, and all will grow old like a garment, and like a covering you will change them, and they will be changed;

28 but you are the same, and your years will not fail.

29 The sons of your slaves will dwell, and their seed will be established forever.

Chapter 102

1 For Dauid. Bless the Lord, my soul, and, all things within me, his holy name;

2 bless the Lord, my soul, and do not forget all his repayments;

3 the one graciously forgiving all your lawless deeds, the one healing all your diseases;

4 the one redeeming your life from corruption, the one crowning you with mercy and compassions;

5 the one filling your desire with good things; your youth will be renewed like an eagle's.

6 The Lord does deeds of mercy and judgment for all those wronged.

7 He made his ways known to Moyses, his wishes to the sons of Israel.

8 Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, patient and abundant in mercy;

9 he will not be angry to the end or bear resentment forever;

10 he did not act toward us according to our sins or repay us according to our lawless deeds,

11 because according to the height of heaven from the earth the Lord strengthened his mercy upon those fearing him;

12 as far as the east is from the west, he distanced our lawless deeds from us.

13 Just as a father pities sons, the Lord pitied those fearing him,

14 because he knew our formation; remember that we are dust.

15 A human, his days are like grass; like a flower of the field, thus he will blossom;

16 because a wind passed through him, and he will not exist and will no longer recognize his place.

17 But the mercy of the Lord is from the age and to the age upon those fearing him, and his righteousness upon sons of sons,

18 for those keeping his covenant and remembering his commandments to do them.

19 The Lord prepared his throne in heaven, and his kingdom rules all things.

20 Bless the Lord, all his angels, mighty in strength, doing his word, to hear the voice of his words;

21 bless the Lord, all his powers, his ministers doing his will;

22 bless the Lord, all his works in every place of his dominion; bless the Lord, my soul.

Chapter 103

1 For Dauid. Bless the Lord, my soul. Lord my God, you were greatly magnified; you clothed yourself with acknowledgment and magnificence,

2 wrapping yourself in light like a garment, stretching out heaven like a hide;

3 the one roofing his upper chambers in waters, the one making clouds his mount, the one walking upon wings of winds;

4 the one making his angels spirits and his ministers burning fire.

5 He founded the earth upon its security; it will not be tilted for the age of the age.

6 An abyss, like a garment, is his covering; waters will stand upon the mountains;

7 at your rebuke they will flee; at the voice of your thunder they will be afraid.

8 Mountains rise and plains descend to the place you founded for them;

9 you placed a boundary which they will not pass, nor will they return to cover the earth.

10 The one sending out springs in ravines; waters will pass between the mountains;

11 they will give drink to all the wild beasts of the field; wild asses will receive for their thirst;

12 upon them the birds of heaven will dwell; from the midst of the rocks they will give a voice.

13 Watering mountains from his upper chambers; from the fruit of your works the earth will be filled.

14 Making grass sprout for the beasts and green plants for the service of humans, to bring bread out of the earth;

15 and wine gladdens a human's heart, to brighten a face with oil, and bread supports a human's heart.

16 The trees of the plain will be filled, the cedars of Libanos which he planted;

17 there sparrows will nest; the house of the heron leads them.

18 The high mountains are for the deer; a rock is a refuge for the rock rabbits.

19 He made a moon for seasons; the sun knew its setting.

20 You placed darkness, and night came to be; in it all the wild beasts of the forest will pass,

21 young lions roaring to seize and seek food for themselves from God.

22 The sun rose, and they gathered, and they will lie down in their enclosures;

23 a human will go out to his work and to his labor until evening.

24 How your works were magnified, Lord; you made all things in wisdom; the earth was filled with your creation.

25 This great and spacious sea, there are creeping things without number, small living creatures with great ones;

26 there ships pass, this dragon which you formed to play with him.

27 All expect you to give them food at the proper time.

28 When you give to them, they will gather; but when you open your hand, all things will be filled with goodness.

29 But when you turn away your face, they will be troubled; you will take away their spirit, and they will fail and return to their dust.

30 You will send forth your spirit, and they will be created, and you will renew the face of the earth.

31 Let the glory of the Lord be forever; the Lord will rejoice in his works;

32 the one looking upon the earth and making it tremble, the one touching the mountains, and they smoke.

33 I will sing to the Lord in my life; I will make music to my God as long as I exist;

34 may my discourse be sweet to him, but I will rejoice in the Lord.

35 May sinners fail from the earth, and lawless ones, so that they do not exist. Bless the Lord, my soul.

Chapter 104

1 Alleluia. Acknowledge the Lord and call upon his name; report his works among the nations;

2 sing to him and make music to him; recount all his wonders.

3 Be praised in his holy name; let the heart of those seeking the Lord rejoice;

4 seek the Lord and be strengthened; seek his face continually.

5 Remember his wonders which he did, his portents and the judgments of his mouth,

6 seed of Abraam, his slaves, sons of Iakob, his chosen ones.

7 He is the Lord our God; his judgments are in all the earth.

8 He remembered his covenant forever, the word he commanded for a thousand generations,

9 which he made with Abraam, and his oath to Isaak,

10 and he established it for Iakob as an ordinance and for Israel as an everlasting covenant,

11 saying: To you I will give the land of Chanaan, a measured portion of your inheritance.

12 When they were few in number, very few and sojourners in it,

13 and they passed from nation to nation, from a kingdom to another people;

14 he did not permit a human to wrong them, and reproved kings on their behalf:

15 Do not touch my anointed ones, and do not act wickedly against my prophets.

16 And he called a famine upon the land; he shattered every support of bread;
17 he sent a human before them; Ioseph was sold as a slave.
18 They humbled his feet in fetters; his soul passed through iron
19 until his word came; the utterance of the Lord refined him by fire.
20 A king sent and released him, a ruler of peoples, and let him go;
21 he made him lord of his house and ruler of all his possessions,
22 to discipline his rulers as himself and make his elders wise.
23 And Israel entered Egypt, and Iakob sojourned in the land of Cham;
24 and he increased his people greatly and strengthened them beyond their enemies.
25 He turned their heart to hate his people, to deal deceitfully with his slaves.
26 He sent forth Moyses his slave, Aaron whom he chose;
27 he placed in them the words of his signs and of his portents in the land of Cham.
28 He sent forth darkness and darkened, and they provoked his words to bitterness.
29 He turned their waters into blood and killed their fish.
30 Their land swarmed with frogs in the chambers of their kings.
31 He spoke, and a dog-fly came, and gnats in all their boundaries.
32 He made their rains hail, burning fire in their land,
33 and struck their vines and their fig trees and shattered every tree of their boundary.
34 He spoke, and a locust came, and a young locust without number,
35 and ate all the grass in their land and ate the fruit of their land.
36 And he struck every firstborn in their land, the firstfruits of all their labor,
37 and brought them out with silver and gold, and among their tribes there was no one weak.
38 Egypt rejoiced at their departure, because fear of them fell upon them.
39 He spread out a cloud as shelter for them, and fire to illuminate the night for them.
40 They asked, and a quail came, and he filled them with bread of heaven;
41 he broke open a rock, and waters flowed; rivers went through waterless places.
42 Because he remembered his holy word to Abraam his slave,
43 and brought out his people in exultation and his chosen ones in gladness.
44 And he gave them lands of nations, and they inherited labors of peoples,
45 so that they might keep his ordinances and seek out his law.

Chapter 105

1 Alleluia. Acknowledge the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

2 Who will speak the mighty deeds of the Lord, make all his praises heard?

3 Blessed are those keeping judgment and doing righteousness at every time.

4 Remember us, Lord, in the good pleasure of your people; visit us with your salvation,

5 to see in the goodness of your chosen ones, to rejoice in the gladness of your nation, to be praised with your inheritance.

6 We sinned with our fathers; we acted lawlessly; we acted unjustly.

7 Our fathers in Egypt did not understand your wonders, did not remember the multitude of your mercy, and provoked bitterness as they went up in the Red Sea.

8 And he saved them because of his name, to make his might known;

9 and he rebuked the Red Sea, and it dried up, and he guided them in an abyss as in a wilderness;

10 and he saved them from the hand of those hating them and redeemed them from an enemy's hand;

11 and water covered those afflicting them; not one of them remained.

12 And they believed in his words and sang his praise.

13 They hastened, they forgot his works; they did not wait for his counsel;

14 and they desired a desire in the wilderness and tested God in a waterless place.

15 And he gave them their request and sent fullness into their souls.

16 And they angered Moyses in the camp, and Aaron, the holy one of the Lord;

17 the earth opened and swallowed Dathan and covered the assembly of Abiron;

18 and fire was kindled in their assembly; a flame burned sinners.

19 And they made a calf in Choreb and bowed to the carved thing;

20 and they exchanged their glory for a likeness of a calf eating grass.

21 They forgot God who saved them, who did great things in Egypt,

22 marvelous things in the land of Cham, fearsome things upon the Red Sea.

23 And he spoke of destroying them, had not Moyses his chosen one stood in the breach before him, to turn away his wrath so as not to destroy.

24 And they despised a desirable land; they did not believe his word;

25 and they grumbled in their dwellings; they did not hear the voice of the Lord.

26 And he lifted his hand against them, to cast them down in the wilderness,

27 and to cast their seed down among the nations and scatter them in the lands.

28 And they were initiated to Beelphegor and ate sacrifices of the dead;

29 and they provoked him with their practices, and the fall multiplied among them.

30 And Phinees stood and made atonement, and the breaking ceased;

31 and it was counted to him as righteousness, to generation and generation forever.

32 And they angered him at water of contradiction, and Moyses was harmed because of them,

33 because they provoked his spirit to bitterness, and he spoke distinctly with his lips.

34 They did not destroy the nations which the Lord told them,

35 and they mingled among the nations and learned their works;

36 and they served their carved things, and it became a stumbling block for them;

37 and they sacrificed their sons and their daughters to demons,

38 and poured out innocent blood, blood of their sons and daughters whom they sacrificed to the carved things of Chanaan, and the land was bloodied with murder in the bloods,

39 and defiled in their works, and they prostituted themselves in their practices.

40 And the Lord was angry with fury against his people and abhorred his inheritance;

41 and he handed them over into hands of nations, and those hating them ruled them;

42 and their enemies afflicted them, and they were humbled beneath their hands.

43 Often he delivered them, but they provoked him to bitterness with their counsel and were humbled in their lawless deeds.

44 And he saw when they were afflicted, when he heard their supplication;

45 and he remembered his covenant and relented according to the multitude of his mercy,

46 and gave them to compassions before all those who took them captive.

47 Save us, Lord our God, and gather us from the nations, to acknowledge your holy name, to boast in your praise.

48 Blessed is the Lord, the God of Israel, from the age and to the age. And all the people will say: May it be, may it be. – –

Chapter 106

1 Alleluia. Acknowledge the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever;

2 let those redeemed by the Lord say it, whom he redeemed from an enemy's hand.

3 From the lands he gathered them, from east and west and north and sea.

4 They wandered in the wilderness, in a waterless place; they did not find a way to a city of habitation,

5 hungering and thirsting; their soul failed within them;

6 and they cried out to the Lord when they were afflicted, and he delivered them from their distresses,

7 and guided them into an upright way, to go to a city of habitation.

8 Let them acknowledge to the Lord his mercies and his wonders for the sons of humans,

9 because he filled an empty soul and filled a hungry soul with good things. –

10 Those sitting in darkness and a shadow of death, fettered in poverty and iron,

11 because they provoked the utterances of God to bitterness and provoked the counsel of the Most High,

12 and their heart was humbled in toils; they grew weak, and there was no one helping;

13 and they cried out to the Lord when they were afflicted, and he saved them from their distresses,

14 and brought them out of darkness and a shadow of death and broke open their bonds.

15 Let them acknowledge to the Lord his mercies and his wonders for the sons of humans,

16 because he shattered bronze gates and broke iron bars. –

17 He took hold of them out of the way of their lawlessness, for because of their lawless deeds they were humbled;

18 their soul abhorred every food, and they approached as far as the gates of death;

19 and they cried out to the Lord when they were afflicted, and he saved them from their distresses;

20 he sent his word and healed them and delivered them from their corruptions.

21 Let them acknowledge to the Lord his mercies and his wonders for the sons of humans,

22 and sacrifice a sacrifice of praise and declare his works in exultation. –

23 Those descending to the sea in ships, doing work in many waters,

24 they saw the works of the Lord and his wonders in the deep;

25 he spoke, and a wind of storm arose, and its waves were exalted;

26 they rise as far as the heavens and descend as far as the abysses; their soul melted in evils;

27 they were troubled, they were shaken like one drunk, and all their wisdom was swallowed;

28 and they cried out to the Lord when they were afflicted, and he brought them out of their distresses,

29 and commanded the storm, and it settled into a breeze, and its waves were silent;

30 and they rejoiced because they were quiet, and he guided them to a harbor of their desire.

31 Let them acknowledge to the Lord his mercies and his wonders for the sons of humans;

32 let them exalt him in an assembly of a people and praise him in a seat of elders. –

33 He made rivers into a wilderness and outlets of waters into thirst,

34 a fruitful land into brine, because of the evil of those dwelling in it.

35 He made a wilderness into lakes of waters and a waterless land into outlets of waters,

36 and settled hungry ones there, and they established a city of habitation,

37 and sowed fields and planted vineyards and made fruit of produce,

38 and he blessed them, and they were greatly multiplied, and he did not diminish their beasts.

39 And they became few and were harmed by affliction of evils and pain.

40 Contempt was poured out upon rulers, and he made them wander in an untrodden place and not a road.

41 And he helped a needy one out of poverty and made families like sheep.

42 Upright ones will see and rejoice, and all lawlessness will stop its mouth.

43 Who is wise and will keep these things, and they will understand the mercies of the Lord?

Chapter 107

1 A song of a psalm for Dauid.

2 My heart is ready, God, my heart is ready; I will sing and make music in my glory.

3 Awake, psaltery and lyre; I will awake at dawn.

4 I will acknowledge you among peoples, Lord, and sing to you among nations,

5 because your mercy is great above the heavens, and your truth as far as the clouds.

6 Be exalted above the heavens, God, and your glory above all the earth.

7 So that your beloved ones may be delivered, save with your right hand and hear me.

8 God spoke in his holy place: I will be exalted and divide Sikima, and measure out the valley of tents;

9 Galaad is mine, and Manasse is mine, and Ephraim is the support of my head, Ioudas my king;

10 Moab is the cauldron of my hope; upon Idumaia I will extend my sandal; foreigners were subjected to me.

11 Who will lead me into a fortified city? Who will guide me as far as Idumaia?

12 Is it not you, God, who rejected us? And you will not go out, God, with our forces.

13 Give us help out of affliction; and a human's salvation is vain.

14 In God we will do mighty deeds, and he will bring our enemies to nothing.

Chapter 108

1 For the end; for Dauid, a psalm. God, do not keep silent concerning my praise,

2 because a sinner's mouth and a deceitful one's mouth were opened against me; they spoke against me with a deceitful tongue,

3 and surrounded me with words of hatred and fought me without cause.

4 In return for loving me they slandered me, but I prayed;

5 and they placed evils against me in return for good things, and hatred in return for my love.

6 Set a sinner over him, and let a slanderer stand at his right;

7 when he is judged, may he go out condemned, and let his prayer become sin.

8 Let his days become few, and may another take his oversight;

9 let his sons become orphans and his wife a widow;

10 let his sons wander in displacement and beg; let them be cast out of their house sites.

11 Let a lender search out all that belongs to him; let strangers plunder his labors;

12 let there be no supporter for him, nor let there be one compassionate toward his orphans;

13 let his children come to destruction; in one generation let his name be blotted out.

14 May the lawlessness of his fathers be remembered before the Lord, and may the sin of his mother not be blotted out;

15 let them be before the Lord continually, and may their remembrance be destroyed from the earth,

16 because he did not remember to do mercy and pursued a human needy and poor and pierced in heart, to put him to death.

17 And he loved a curse, and it will come to him; and he did not desire a blessing, and it will be distanced from him.

18 And he clothed himself with a curse like a garment, and it entered like water into his inward parts and like oil into his bones;

19 let it become for him like a garment he wraps around himself, and like a belt he continually girds himself with.

20 This is the work from the Lord for those slandering me and those speaking evil things against my soul.

21 And you, Lord, Lord, do mercy with me because of your name, because your mercy is good.

22 Deliver me, because I am poor and needy, and my heart is troubled within me.

23 Like a shadow when it declines, I was taken away; I was shaken off like locusts.

24 My knees grew weak from fasting, and my flesh was changed because of oil.

25 And I became a reproach to them; they saw me, they shook their heads.

26 Help me, Lord my God; save me according to your mercy,

27 and let them know that this is your hand, and you, Lord, did it.

28 They will curse, and you will bless; let those rising against me be ashamed, but your slave will rejoice.

29 Let those slandering me clothe themselves in disgrace and wrap their shame around themselves like a double cloak.

30 I will greatly acknowledge the Lord with my mouth and praise him in the midst of many,

31 because he stood at the right of a needy one, to save from those pursuing my soul.

Chapter 109

1 For Dauid, a psalm. The Lord said to my lord: Sit at my right, until I make your enemies a footstool for your feet.

2 The Lord will send forth a rod of your strength from Sion, and rule in the midst of your enemies.

3 With you is rule on the day of your strength, in the splendors of the holy ones; from the womb before the morning star I begot you.

4 The Lord swore and will not relent: You are a priest forever according to the order of Melchisedek.

5 The Lord at your right crushed kings on the day of his wrath;

6 he will judge among the nations; he will fill with corpses; he will crush heads upon the land of many.

7 He will drink from a torrent on the way; for this reason he will exalt a head.

Chapter 110

1 Alleluia. I will acknowledge you, Lord, with my whole heart, in a council of upright ones and an assembly.

2 Great are the works of the Lord, sought out for all his wishes;

3 acknowledgment and magnificence are his work, and his righteousness remains for the age of the age.

4 He made a remembrance of his wonders; merciful and compassionate is the Lord;

5 he gave food to those fearing him; he will remember his covenant forever.

6 He announced the strength of his works to his people, to give them an inheritance of nations.

7 The works of his hands are truth and judgment; all his commandments are faithful,

8 supported for the age of the age, made in truth and uprightness.

9 He sent redemption to his people; he commanded his covenant forever; holy and fearsome is his name.

10 The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord; good understanding is for all those doing it. His praise remains for the age of the age.

Chapter 111

1 Alleluia. Blessed is a man fearing the Lord; he will greatly desire his commandments;

2 his seed will be mighty in the land; a generation of upright ones will be blessed;

3 glory and wealth are in his house, and his righteousness remains for the age of the age.

4 Light rose in darkness for the upright, merciful and compassionate and righteous.

5 Good is a man who pities and lends; he will manage his words with judgment;

6 because he will not be shaken forever; a righteous one will be in everlasting remembrance.

7 He will not be afraid of an evil report; his heart is ready to hope in the Lord.

8 His heart has been supported; he will certainly not be afraid, until he looks upon his enemies.

9 He scattered, he gave to the needy; his righteousness remains for the age of the age; his horn will be exalted in glory.

10 A sinner will see and be angry; he will gnash his teeth and melt; the desire of sinners will perish.

Chapter 112

1 Alleluia. Praise the Lord, servants; praise the name of the Lord;

2 may the name of the Lord be blessed from now and forever;

3 from the rising of the sun until its setting praise the name of the Lord.

4 The Lord is high over all the nations; his glory is above the heavens.

5 Who is like the Lord our God, who dwells in the heights

6 and looks upon the low things in heaven and on earth?

7 The one raising a poor one from the earth and lifting a needy one from dung,

8 to seat him with rulers, with rulers of his people;

9 the one settling a barren woman in a house as a rejoicing mother of children.

Chapter 113

1 Alleluia. At the departure of Israel from Egypt, of the house of Iakob from a barbarian people,

2 Ioudaia became his sanctuary, Israel his authority.

3 The sea saw and fled; Iordanes turned backward;

4 the mountains leaped like rams, and the hills like lambs of sheep.

5 What is with you, sea, that you fled, and with you, Iordanes, that you withdrew backward?

6 Mountains, that you leaped like rams, and hills like lambs of sheep?

7 Before the face of the Lord the earth was shaken, before the face of the God of Iakob,

8 who turned the rock into lakes of waters and the sheer rock into springs of waters.

9 Not to us, Lord, not to us, but to your name give glory, for your mercy and your truth,

10 lest the nations say: Where is their God?

11 But our God is in heaven above; in the heavens and on the earth he did all that he wished.

12 The idols of the nations are silver and gold, works of human hands;

13 they have a mouth and will not speak; they have eyes and will not see;

14 they have ears and will not hear; they have noses and will not smell;

15 they have hands and will not feel; they have feet and will not walk; they will not give a voice in their throat.

16 May those making them become like them, and all those trusting in them.

17 The house of Israel hoped in the Lord; he is their helper and their defender.

18 The house of Aaron hoped in the Lord; he is their helper and their defender.

19 Those fearing the Lord hoped in the Lord; he is their helper and their defender.

20 The Lord remembered us and blessed us; he blessed the house of Israel; he blessed the house of Aaron;

21 he blessed those fearing the Lord, the small with the great.

22 May the Lord add to you, to you and to your sons;

23 you are blessed by the Lord who made heaven and earth.

24 The heaven of heaven belongs to the Lord, but the earth he gave to the sons of humans.

25 The dead will not praise you, Lord, nor all those descending into Hades,

26 but we, the living, will bless the Lord from now and forever.

Chapter 114

1 Alleluia. I loved, because the Lord will hear the voice of my supplication,

2 because he inclined his ear to me, and in my days I will call upon him.

3 Birth pangs of death encompassed me; dangers of Hades found me; I found affliction and pain.

4 And I called upon the name of the Lord: O Lord, deliver my soul.

5 Merciful and righteous is the Lord, and our God has mercy.

6 The Lord guards the infants; I was humbled, and he saved me.

7 Turn back, my soul, to your rest, because the Lord benefited you,

8 because he delivered my soul from death, my eyes from tears and my feet from slipping.

9 I will be pleasing before the Lord in a land of the living.

Chapter 115

1 Alleluia. I believed, therefore I spoke; but I was greatly humbled.

2 I said in my ecstasy: Every human is a liar.

3 What will I repay to the Lord for all that he repaid to me?

4 I will take a cup of salvation and call upon the name of the Lord.

6 Honored before the Lord is the death of his holy ones.

7 O Lord, I am your slave, I am your slave and son of your maidservant. You broke open my bonds;

8 to you I will sacrifice a sacrifice of praise;

9 I will pay my vows to the Lord before all his people,

10 in the courts of the house of the Lord, in your midst, Ierousalem.

Chapter 116

1 Alleluia. Praise the Lord, all the nations; praise him, all the peoples,

2 because his mercy was strengthened upon us, and the truth of the Lord remains forever.

Chapter 117

1 Alleluia. Acknowledge the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

2 Let the house of Israel say, then, that he is good, that his mercy is forever;

3 let the house of Aaron say, then, that he is good, that his mercy is forever;

4 let all those fearing the Lord say, then, that he is good, that his mercy is forever.

5 In affliction I called upon the Lord, and he heard me into spaciousness.

6 The Lord is a helper for me; I will not fear what a human will do to me.

7 The Lord is a helper for me, and I will look upon my enemies.

8 It is better to trust in the Lord than to trust in a human;

9 it is better to hope in the Lord than to hope in rulers.

10 All the nations surrounded me, and in the name of the Lord I warded them off;

11 surrounding, they surrounded me, and in the name of the Lord I warded them off;

12 they surrounded me like bees a honeycomb and were kindled like fire in thorns, and in the name of the Lord I warded them off.

13 Being pushed, I was overturned to fall, and the Lord supported me.

14 The Lord is my strength and my hymn, and he became salvation for me.

15 A voice of exultation and salvation in tents of righteous ones: The right hand of the Lord did a mighty deed;

16 the right hand of the Lord exalted me; the right hand of the Lord did a mighty deed.

17 I will not die, but live and recount the works of the Lord.

18 Disciplining, the Lord disciplined me, and did not hand me over to death.

19 Open gates of righteousness for me; entering them, I will acknowledge the Lord.

20 This is the gate of the Lord; righteous ones will enter it.

21 I will acknowledge you, because you heard me and became salvation for me.

22 A stone which the builders rejected, this became the head of a corner;

23 this came to be from the Lord, and it is marvelous in our eyes.

24 This is the day which the Lord made; let us exult and rejoice in it.

25 O Lord, save, then; O Lord, prosper, then.

26 Blessed is the one coming in the name of the Lord; we have blessed you from the house of the Lord.

27 The Lord is God and shone upon us; establish a feast with those covering with branches, as far as the horns of the altar.

28 You are my God, and I will acknowledge you; you are my God, and I will exalt you; I will acknowledge you, because you heard me and became salvation for me.

29 Acknowledge the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

Chapter 118

1 Alleluia. 1. Alph. Blessed are the blameless in a way, those walking in the law of the Lord.

2 Blessed are those searching out his testimonies; with a whole heart they will seek him out.

3 For those working lawlessness did not walk in his ways.

4 You commanded that your commandments be kept diligently.

5 Would that my ways were directed to keep your ordinances.

6 Then I will certainly not be ashamed when I look upon all your commandments.

7 I will acknowledge you, Lord, in uprightness of heart, when I have learned the judgments of your righteousness.

8 I will keep your ordinances; do not abandon me utterly.

9 2. Beth. By what will the younger one set his way right? By keeping your words.

10 With my whole heart I sought you out; do not thrust me away from your commandments.

11 In my heart I hid your utterances, so that I might not sin against you.

12 You are blessed, Lord; teach me your ordinances.

13 With my lips I declared all the judgments of your mouth.

14 In the way of your testimonies I delighted as in all wealth.

15 I will ponder your commandments and perceive your ways.

16 I will meditate upon your ordinances; I will not forget your words.

17 3. Gimal. Repay your slave; I will live and keep your words.

18 Uncover my eyes, and I will perceive your wonders from your law.

19 I am a sojourner in the earth; do not hide your commandments from me.

20 My soul longed to desire your judgments at every time.

21 You rebuked arrogant ones; cursed are those turning aside from your commandments.

22 Remove reproach and contempt from me, because I sought out your testimonies.

23 For indeed rulers sat and spoke against me, but your slave pondered your ordinances.

24 For indeed your testimonies are my meditation, and your ordinances my counsels.

25 4. Delth. My soul clung to the ground; give me life according to your word.

26 I declared my ways, and you heard me; teach me your ordinances.

27 Make me understand the way of your ordinances, and I will ponder your wonders.

28 My soul dripped from weariness; confirm me in your words.

29 Remove a way of injustice from me, and have mercy on me with your law.

30 I chose a way of truth; I did not forget your judgments.

31 I clung to your testimonies; Lord, do not put me to shame.

32 I ran a way of your commandments when you widened my heart.

33 5. E. Instruct me by law, Lord, in the way of your ordinances, and I will seek it out continually.

34 Make me understand, and I will search out your law and keep it with my whole heart.

35 Guide me in a path of your commandments, because I desired it.

36 Incline my heart to your testimonies and not to greed.

37 Turn my eyes away so as not to see vanity; in your way give me life.

38 Establish your utterance for your slave, for fear of you.

39 Remove my reproach which I suspected; for your judgments are good.

40 Behold, I desired your commandments; in your righteousness give me life.

41 6. Ouau. And may your mercy come upon me, Lord, your salvation according to your utterance.

42 And I will answer those reproaching me with a word, because I hoped in your words.

43 And do not remove a word of truth from my mouth utterly, because I hoped in your judgments.

44 And I will keep your law continually, forever and for the age of the age.

45 And I walked in spaciousness, because I sought out your commandments.

46 And I spoke of your testimonies before kings and was not ashamed.

47 And I meditated upon your commandments which I loved greatly.

48 And I lifted my hands toward your commandments which I loved, and pondered your ordinances.

49 7. Zai. Remember your word to your slave, by which you made me hope.

50 This comforted me in my humiliation, because your utterance gave me life.

51 Arrogant ones acted lawlessly to an extreme, but I did not turn aside from your law.

52 I remembered your judgments from the age, Lord, and was comforted.

53 Despondency seized me because of sinners abandoning your law.

54 Your ordinances were songs for me in the place of my sojourning.

55 I remembered your name in the night, Lord, and kept your law.

56 This came to be for me, because I sought out your ordinances.

57 8. Eth. My portion, Lord; I said that I would keep your law.

58 I supplicated your face with my whole heart; have mercy on me according to your utterance.

59 I considered your ways and turned my feet back to your testimonies.

60 I was prepared and was not troubled to keep your commandments.

61 Cords of sinners entwined me, and I did not forget your law.

62 At midnight I rose to acknowledge you for the judgments of your righteousness.

63 I am a companion of all those fearing you and those keeping your commandments.

64 The earth is full of your mercy, Lord; teach me your ordinances.

65 9. Teth. You did goodness with your slave, Lord, according to your word.

66 Teach me goodness and discipline and knowledge, because I believed your commandments.

67 Before I was humbled I transgressed; for this reason I kept your utterance.

68 You are good, Lord, and in your goodness teach me your ordinances.

69 The injustice of arrogant ones was multiplied against me, but with my whole heart I will search out your commandments.

70 Their heart curdled like milk, but I meditated upon your law.

71 It is good for me that you humbled me, so that I might learn your ordinances.

72 The law of your mouth is good for me beyond thousands of gold and silver.

73 10. Ioth. Your hands made me and formed me; make me understand, and I will learn your commandments.

74 Those fearing you will see me and rejoice, because I hoped in your words.

75 I knew, Lord, that your judgments are righteousness, and in truth you humbled me.

76 Let your mercy, then, come to comfort me, according to your utterance to your slave.

77 Let your compassions come to me, and I will live, because your law is my meditation.

78 Let arrogant ones be ashamed, because unjustly they acted lawlessly against me; but I will ponder your commandments.

79 Let those fearing you and those knowing your testimonies turn back to me.

80 Let my heart become blameless in your ordinances, so that I may not be ashamed.

81 11. Chaph. My soul fails for your salvation, and I hoped in your word.

82 My eyes failed for your utterance, saying: When will you comfort me?

83 Because I became like a wineskin in frost; I did not forget your ordinances.

84 How many are the days of your slave? When will you make judgment for me against those pursuing me?

85 Lawless ones recounted idle talk to me, but not like your law, Lord.

86 All your commandments are truth; they pursued me unjustly; help me.

87 They nearly finished me in the earth, but I did not abandon your commandments.

88 According to your mercy give me life, and I will keep the testimonies of your mouth.

89 12. Labd. Forever, Lord, your word remains in heaven.

90 Your truth is to generation and generation; you founded the earth, and it remains.

91 By your ordinance the day remains, because all things are your slaves.

92 If your law were not my meditation, then I would have perished in my humiliation.

93 I will certainly never forget your ordinances, because in them you gave me life, Lord.

94 I am yours; save me, because I sought out your ordinances.

95 Sinners waited for me to destroy me; I understood your testimonies.

96 I saw an end of every completion; your commandment is very broad.

97 13. Mem. How I loved your law, Lord; all day it is my meditation.

98 Beyond my enemies you made me wise in your commandment, because it is mine forever.

99 Beyond all those teaching me I understood, because your testimonies are my meditation.

100 Beyond elders I understood, because I sought out your commandments.

101 From every evil way I restrained my feet, so that I might keep your words.

102 I did not turn aside from your judgments, because you instructed me by law.

103 How sweet your utterances are to my throat, beyond honey and honeycomb to my mouth.

104 From your commandments I understood; for this reason I hated every way of injustice. [Because you instructed me by law.]

105 14. Noun. Your word is a lamp for my feet and a light for my paths.

106 I have sworn and established that I would keep the judgments of your righteousness.

107 I was humbled to an extreme; Lord, give me life according to your word.

108 Take pleasure, then, Lord, in the willing offerings of my mouth, and teach me your judgments.

109 My soul is in my hands continually, and I did not forget your law.

110 Sinners placed a trap for me, and I did not stray from your commandments.

111 I inherited your testimonies forever, because they are the rejoicing of my heart.

112 I inclined my heart to do your ordinances forever, for recompense.

113 15. Samch. I hated lawless ones and loved your law.

114 You are my helper and my supporter; I hoped in your word.

115 Turn aside from me, those doing evil, and I will search out the commandments of my God.

116 Support me according to your utterance, and I will live, and do not put me to shame in my expectation.

117 Help me, and I will be saved and meditate upon your ordinances continually.

118 You despised all those departing from your ordinances, because their thought is unjust.

119 I counted all the sinners of the earth as transgressors; for this reason I loved your testimonies continually.

120 Nail down my flesh from fear of you; for I was afraid of your judgments.

121 16. Ain. I did judgment and righteousness; do not hand me over to those wronging me.

122 Receive your slave for good; let arrogant ones not falsely accuse me.

123 My eyes failed for your salvation and for the utterance of your righteousness.

124 Act with your slave according to your mercy, and teach me your ordinances.

125 I am your slave; make me understand, and I will know your testimonies.

126 It is time for the Lord to act; they scattered your law.

127 For this reason I loved your commandments beyond gold and topaz.

128 For this reason I was directed toward all your commandments; I hated every unjust way.

129 17. Phe. Marvelous are your testimonies; for this reason my soul searched them out.

130 The disclosure of your words will give light and make infants understand.

131 I opened my mouth and drew breath, because I longed for your commandments.

132 Look upon me and have mercy on me, according to the judgment for those loving your name.

133 Direct my steps according to your utterance, and let no lawlessness rule me.

134 Redeem me from false accusation of humans, and I will keep your commandments.

135 Make your face shine upon your slave and teach me your ordinances.

136 My eyes brought down streams of waters, since they did not keep your law.

137 18. Sade. You are righteous, Lord, and your judgment is upright.

138 You commanded your testimonies as righteousness and great truth.

139 The zeal of your house melted me away, because my enemies forgot your words.

140 Your utterance has been greatly refined by fire, and your slave loved it.

141 I am younger and despised; I did not forget your ordinances.

142 Your righteousness is righteousness forever, and your law is truth.

143 Affliction and distress found me; your commandments are my meditation.

144 Your testimonies are righteousness forever; make me understand, and I will live.

145 19. Koph. I cried out with my whole heart; hear me, Lord; I will seek out your ordinances.

146 I cried out to you; save me, and I will keep your testimonies.

147 I went before at an untimely hour and cried out; I hoped in your words.

148 My eyes went before toward dawn, to meditate upon your utterances.

149 Hear my voice, Lord, according to your mercy; according to your judgment give me life.

150 Those pursuing me with lawlessness drew near, but they were distanced from your law.

151 You are near, Lord, and all your commandments are truth.

152 From the beginning I knew from your testimonies that you founded them forever.

153 20. Res. See my humiliation and deliver me, because I did not forget your law.

154 Judge my judgment and redeem me; because of your word give me life.

155 Salvation is far from sinners, because they did not seek out your ordinances.

156 Your compassions are many, Lord; according to your judgment give me life.

157 Many are those pursuing me and pressing me hard; I did not turn aside from your testimonies.

158 I saw those breaking faith and melted away, because they did not keep your utterances.

159 See that I loved your commandments; Lord, in your mercy give me life.

160 The beginning of your words is truth, and all the judgments of your righteousness are forever.

161 21. Sen. Rulers pursued me without cause, and my heart was afraid of your words.

162 I will exult in your utterances like one finding many spoils.

163 I hated and abhorred injustice, but I loved your law.

164 Seven times in the day I praised you for the judgments of your righteousness.

165 Much peace belongs to those loving your law, and there is no stumbling block for them.

166 I expected your salvation, Lord, and loved your commandments.

167 My soul kept your testimonies and loved them greatly.

168 I kept your commandments and your testimonies, because all my ways are before you, Lord.

169 22. Thau. Let my supplication approach before you, Lord; according to your utterance make me understand.

170 May my petition enter before you; according to your utterance deliver me.

171 May my lips pour forth a hymn when you teach me your ordinances.

172 May my tongue utter your utterance, because all your commandments are righteousness.

173 Let your hand be to save me, because I chose your commandments.

174 I longed for your salvation, Lord, and your law is my meditation.

175 My soul will live and praise you, and your judgments will help me.

176 I strayed like a lost sheep; seek your slave, because I did not forget your commandments.

Chapter 119

1 A song of the ascents. To the Lord I cried out when I was afflicted, and he heard me.

2 Lord, deliver my soul from unjust lips and from a deceitful tongue.

3 What might be given to you, and what might be added to you against a deceitful tongue?

4 The sharpened arrows of the mighty one, with the wilderness coals.

5 Alas for me, because my sojourning was prolonged; I dwelt with the dwellings of Kedar.

6 My soul sojourned much.

7 With those hating peace I was peaceful; when I spoke to them, they fought me without cause.

Chapter 120

1 A song of the ascents. I lifted my eyes to the mountains. From where will my help come?

2 My help is from the Lord, who made heaven and earth.

3 Do not give your foot over to shaking, nor may he who guards you slumber.

4 Behold, he who guards Israel will neither slumber nor sleep.

5 The Lord will guard you; the Lord is your shelter at your right hand;

6 by day the sun will not burn you, nor the moon by night.

7 The Lord will guard you from every evil; he will guard your soul.

8 The Lord will guard your entrance and your exit from now and unto the age.

Chapter 121

1 A song of the ascents. I rejoiced at those who said to me, We shall go to the house of the Lord.

2 Our feet were standing in your courts, Ierousalem.

3 Ierousalem, being built as a city whose participation is together.

4 For there the tribes went up, tribes of the Lord, a testimony to Israel, to acknowledge the name of the Lord;

5 because there sat thrones for judgment, thrones over the house of Dauid.

6 Ask Ierousalem, then, for the things pertaining to peace, and prosperity for those who love you;

7 let there be peace, then, in your strength and prosperity in your towered fortresses.

8 For the sake of my brothers and my neighbors I was speaking peace, then, concerning you;

9 for the sake of the house of the Lord our God I sought good things for you.

Chapter 122

1 A song of the ascents. To you I lifted my eyes, to the one dwelling in heaven.

2 Behold, as the eyes of slaves are toward the hands of their masters, as the eyes of a maidservant are toward the hands of her mistress, so our eyes are toward the Lord our God, until he may have compassion on us.

3 Have mercy on us, Lord, have mercy on us, because we were greatly filled with contempt,

4 our soul was filled still more. Reproach to those who prosper, and contempt to the arrogant.

Chapter 123

1 A song of the ascents. If it had not been that the Lord was among us, let Israel say, then,

2 if it had not been that the Lord was among us when people rose up against us,

3 then they would have swallowed us alive when their wrath was kindled against us;

4 then the water drowned us; our soul passed through a torrent;

5 then our soul passed through the water that cannot be withstood.

6 Blessed is the Lord, who did not give us as prey to their teeth.

7 Our soul was delivered like a little bird from the snare of the hunters; the snare was shattered, and we were delivered.

8 Our help is in the name of the Lord, who made heaven and earth.

Chapter 124

1 A song of the ascents. Those who trust in the Lord are like Mount Sion; he who dwells in Ierousalem will not be shaken unto the age.

2 Mountains are around her, and the Lord is around his people from now and unto the age.

3 Because he will not leave the rod of sinners upon the lot of the righteous, so that the righteous may not stretch out their hands in lawlessness.

4 Do good, Lord, to the good and to those upright in heart;

5 but those who turn aside into crooked ways the Lord will lead away with those who work lawlessness. Peace upon Israel.

Chapter 125

1 A song of the ascents. When the Lord turned back the captivity of Sion, we became like those comforted.

2 Then our mouth was filled with joy, and our tongue with exultation. Then they will say among the nations, The Lord did great things in acting with them.

3 The Lord did great things in acting with us; we became glad.

4 Turn back our captivity, Lord, like torrents in the south.

5 Those who sow in tears will reap in exultation.

6 Going, they were going and weeping, carrying their seeds; but coming, they will come in exultation, carrying their sheaves.

Chapter 126

1 A song of the ascents; for Salomon. Unless the Lord builds a house, those who build it labored in vain; unless the Lord guards a city, the one guarding kept awake in vain.

2 It is in vain for you to rise early, to get up after sitting down, you who eat bread of pain, when he gives sleep to his beloved ones.

3 Behold, sons are the inheritance of the Lord, the reward of the fruit of the womb.

4 Like arrows in the hand of a mighty one, so are the sons of those shaken off.

5 Blessed is a person who will fill his desire from them; they will not be put to shame when they speak to their enemies in a gate.

Chapter 127

1 A song of the ascents. Blessed are all who fear the Lord, who walk in his ways.

2 You will eat the labors of your wrists; you are blessed, and it will be well with you.

3 Your wife is like a flourishing vine in the sides of your house; your sons are like newly planted olive trees around your table.

4 Behold, thus will a person who fears the Lord be blessed.

5 May the Lord bless you from Sion, and may you see the good things of Ierousalem all the days of your life;

6 and may you see sons of your sons. Peace upon Israel.

Chapter 128

1 A song of the ascents. Many times they made war on me from my youth, let Israel say, then,

2 many times they made war on me from my youth, for indeed they did not prevail against me.

3 On my back the sinners were working; they lengthened their lawlessness;

4 The righteous Lord cut apart the necks of sinners.

5 Let all who hate Sion be put to shame and turned backward.

6 Let them become like grass on housetops, which dried up before being pulled out;

7 with which the reaper did not fill his hand, nor the one gathering the sheaves his bosom,

8 and those passing by did not say, The blessing of the Lord upon you; we have blessed you in the name of the Lord.

Chapter 129

1 A song of the ascents. From the depths I cried to you, Lord;

2 Lord, hear my voice; let your ears become attentive to the voice of my supplication.

3 If you watch lawless deeds, Lord, Lord, who will stand?

4 Because with you is propitiation.

5 For the sake of your law I waited for you, Lord; my soul waited for your word.

6 My soul hoped in the Lord from the morning watch until night; from the morning watch let Israel hope in the Lord.

7 Because with the Lord is mercy, and with him is much redemption,

8 and he will redeem Israel from all his lawless deeds.

Chapter 130

1 A song of the ascents; for Dauid. Lord, my heart was not exalted, nor were my eyes lifted high, nor did I walk in great things or in marvelous things beyond me.

2 If I was not humble-minded, but raised my soul like the weaned child toward its mother, like a repayment upon my soul.

3 Let Israel hope in the Lord from now and unto the age.

Chapter 131

1 A song of the ascents. Remember, Lord, Dauid and all his meekness,

2 how he swore to the Lord, vowed to the God of Iakob,

3 I shall not enter the dwelling of my house, I shall not go up upon the bed of my bedding,

4 I shall not give sleep to my eyes and slumber to my eyelids and rest to my temples,

5 until I find a place for the Lord, a dwelling for the God of Iakob.

6 Behold, we heard of her in Ephratha; we found her in the plains of the woodland;

7 we shall enter his dwellings; we shall bow down toward the place where his feet stood.

8 Rise, Lord, into your rest, you and the ark of your sanctification;

9 your priests will clothe themselves with righteousness, and your holy ones will exult.

10 For the sake of Dauid your slave, do not turn away the face of your anointed one.

11 The Lord swore truth to Dauid, and he will certainly not annul it: From the fruit of your belly I shall set upon your throne;

12 if your sons keep my covenant and these testimonies of mine which I shall teach them, their sons also will sit upon your throne unto the age.

13 Because the Lord chose Sion, he selected her as a habitation for himself:

14 This is my rest unto an age of an age; here I shall dwell, because I selected her;

15 blessing, I shall bless her prey; I shall satisfy her poor with bread;

16 I shall clothe her priests with salvation, and her holy ones will exult with exultation;

17 there I shall cause a horn to spring up for Dauid; I prepared a lamp for my anointed one;

18 I shall clothe his enemies with shame, but upon him my sanctification will blossom.

Chapter 132

1 A song of the ascents; for Dauid. Behold, then, what is good or what is pleasant except brothers dwelling together?

2 Like ointment upon a head, which descends upon a beard, the beard of Aaron, which descends upon the edge of his garment;

3 like the dew of Aermon, which descends upon the mountains of Sion; because there the Lord commanded the blessing and life unto the age.

Chapter 133

1 A song of the ascents. Behold, then, bless the Lord, all you slaves of the Lord who stand in the house of the Lord, in the courts of the house of our God.

2 In the nights lift your hands toward the holy places and bless the Lord.

3 The Lord will bless you from Sion, he who made heaven and earth.

Chapter 134

1 Alleluia. Praise the name of the Lord; praise the Lord, slaves,

2 you who stand in the house of the Lord, in the courts of the house of our God.

3 Praise the Lord, because the Lord is good; sing to his name, because it is beautiful;

4 because the Lord chose Iakob for himself, Israel as his own possession.

5 Because I knew that the Lord is great, and our Lord is beyond all the gods;

6 all things that the Lord wished, he did in heaven and on earth, in the seas and in all the abysses;

7 bringing up clouds from the end of the earth, he made lightnings for rain; he who brings out winds from his treasuries.

8 He who struck the firstborn of Egypt, from human to beast;

9 he sent out signs and wonders in your midst, Egypt, upon Pharao and upon all his slaves.

10 He who struck many nations and killed mighty kings,

11 Seon king of the Amorrites and Og king of Basan and all the kingdoms of Chanaan,

12 and gave their land as an inheritance, an inheritance to Israel his people.

13 Lord, your name is unto the age; Lord, your memorial is unto generation and generation.

14 Because the Lord will judge his people, and concerning his slaves he will be comforted.

15 The idols of the nations are silver and gold, works of human hands;

16 they have a mouth and will not speak; they have eyes and will not see;

17 they have ears and will not listen; [they have noses and will not smell; they have hands and will not feel; they have feet and will not walk; they will not utter a sound in their throat;] for there is not even breath in their mouth.

18 May those who make them become like them, and all who trust in them.

19 House of Israel, bless the Lord; house of Aaron, bless the Lord;

20 house of Leui, bless the Lord; you who fear the Lord, bless the Lord.

21 Blessed is the Lord from Sion, he who dwells in Ierousalem.

Chapter 135

1 Alleluia. Acknowledge the Lord, because he is kind, because his mercy is unto the age;

2 acknowledge the God of gods, because his mercy is unto the age;

3 acknowledge the Lord of lords, because his mercy is unto the age;

4 him who alone does great marvelous things, because his mercy is unto the age;

5 him who made the heavens with understanding, because his mercy is unto the age;

6 him who established the earth upon the waters, because his mercy is unto the age;

7 him who alone made great lights, because his mercy is unto the age,

8 the sun for authority over the day, because his mercy is unto the age,

9 the moon and the stars for authority over the night, because his mercy is unto the age;

10 him who struck Egypt together with their firstborn, because his mercy is unto the age,

11 and brought Israel out from their midst, because his mercy is unto the age,

12 with a mighty hand and with a high arm, because his mercy is unto the age;

13 him who divided the Red Sea into divisions, because his mercy is unto the age,

14 and led Israel through its midst, because his mercy is unto the age,

15 and shook off Pharao and his force into the Red Sea, because his mercy is unto the age;

16 him who led his people through the wilderness, because his mercy is unto the age; him who brought out water from a sheer rock, because his mercy is unto the age;

17 him who struck great kings, because his mercy is unto the age,

18 and killed mighty kings, because his mercy is unto the age,

19 Seon king of the Amorrites, because his mercy is unto the age,

20 and Og king of Basan, because his mercy is unto the age,

21 and gave their land as an inheritance, because his mercy is unto the age,

22 an inheritance to Israel his slave, because his mercy is unto the age.

23 Because in our humiliation the Lord remembered us, because his mercy is unto the age,

24 and redeemed us from our enemies, because his mercy is unto the age;

25 he who gives food to all flesh, because his mercy is unto the age.

26 Acknowledge the God of heaven, because his mercy is unto the age; acknowledge the Lord of lords, because his mercy is unto the age.

Chapter 136

1 For Dauid. By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat and wept when we remembered Sion.

2 Upon the willows in her midst we hung our instruments;

3 because there those who took us captive asked us for words of songs, and those who led us away for a hymn: Sing to us from the songs of Sion.

4 How shall we sing the song of the Lord upon a foreign land?

5 If I forget you, Ierousalem, may my right hand be forgotten;

6 may my tongue cling to my throat if I do not remember you, if I do not set Ierousalem first at the beginning of my gladness.

7 Remember, Lord, the sons of Edom on the day of Ierousalem, those who said, Empty out, empty out, down to the foundation in her.

8 Wretched daughter of Babylon, blessed is he who will repay you your repayment which you repaid us;

9 blessed is he who will seize and dash your infants against the rock.

Chapter 137

1 For Dauid. I shall acknowledge you, Lord, with my whole heart, because you heard the words of my mouth, and before angels I shall sing to you.

2 I shall bow down toward your holy temple and acknowledge your name for your mercy and your truth, because you magnified your oracle above every name.

3 On whatever day I call upon you, hear me quickly; you will regard me greatly in my soul with strength.

4 Let all the kings of the earth acknowledge you, Lord, because they heard all the words of your mouth,

5 and let them sing in the ways of the Lord, because great is the glory of the Lord,

6 because the Lord is high and looks upon the lowly things, and knows the lofty things from afar.

7 If I walk in the midst of affliction, you will give me life; against the wrath of my enemies you stretched out your hand, and your right hand saved me.

8 The Lord will repay on my behalf. Lord, your mercy is unto the age; do not abandon the works of your hands.

Chapter 138

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid. Lord, you tested me and knew me;

2 you knew my sitting and my rising; you understood my reasonings from afar;

3 you traced out my path and my measuring cord, and foresaw all my ways.

4 Because there is no word on my tongue,

5 behold, Lord, you knew all things, the last and the ancient; you formed me and laid your hand upon me.

6 Your knowledge became marvelous beyond me; it became mighty; I certainly cannot attain to it.

7 Where shall I go from your spirit, and where shall I flee from your face?

8 If I go up into heaven, you are there; if I go down into Hades, you are present;

9 if I were to take up my wings at dawn and encamp at the ends of the sea,

10 for even there your hand will lead me, and your right hand will hold me.

11 And I said, Then darkness will trample me, and night is illumination in my delight;

12 because darkness will not be darkened from you, and night will be illuminated like day; as its darkness, so also its light.

13 Because you acquired my kidneys, Lord; you took hold of me from my mother's womb.

14 I shall acknowledge you, because I was fearfully made marvelous; marvelous are your works, and my soul knows exceedingly.

15 My bone, which you made in secret, was not hidden from you. And my substance is in the lowest parts of the earth;

16 your eyes saw my unworked substance, and in your book all will be written; by day they will be formed, and none among them.

17 But to me your friends were greatly honored, God; their beginnings became greatly mighty;

18 I shall count them, and they will be multiplied beyond sand; I awoke, and I am still with you.

19 If you kill sinners, God, men of bloods, turn aside from me.

20 Because you will speak for a reasoning; they will take your cities for vanity.

21 Did I not hate those who hate you, Lord, and was I not wasting away over your enemies?

22 I hated them with a complete hatred; they became enemies to me.

23 Test me, God, and know my heart; examine me and know my paths,

24 and see whether a way of lawlessness is in me, and lead me in an eternal way.

Chapter 139

1 For the end; a psalm for Dauid.

2 Rescue me, Lord, from an evil person; deliver me from an unjust man,

3 who reasoned out injustices in their heart; the whole day they were arraying wars;

4 they sharpened their tongue like a serpent's; venom of asps is under their lips. Interlude.

5 Guard me, Lord, from a sinner's hand; rescue me from unjust people, who reasoned out how to trip my steps;

6 arrogant ones hid a snare for me and stretched out cords, snares for my feet; beside a path they set a stumbling block for me. Interlude.

7 I said to the Lord, You are my God; listen, Lord, to the voice of my supplication.

8 Lord, Lord, strength of my salvation, you overshadowed my head on a day of war.

9 Do not hand me over, Lord, from my desire to a sinner; they reasoned against me; do not forsake me, lest they be exalted. Interlude.

10 The head of their encirclement, the toil of their lips will cover them.

11 Coals will fall upon them; you will cast them down in fire; in miseries they will certainly not stand.

12 A talkative man will not be set straight upon the earth; evils will hunt an unjust man into destruction.

13 I knew that the Lord will execute the judgment of the poor and the justice of the needy.

14 Indeed, the righteous will acknowledge your name, and the upright will dwell with your face.

Chapter 140

1 A psalm for Dauid. Lord, I cried to you; hear me; attend to the voice of my supplication when I cry to you.

2 Let my prayer be directed like incense before you, the lifting of my hands an evening sacrifice.

3 Set, Lord, a guard for my mouth and a door of enclosure around my lips.

4 Do not incline my heart to words of wickedness, to make excuses in sins with people who work lawlessness, and I shall certainly not join with their chosen ones.

5 A righteous one will discipline me with mercy and reprove me, but let a sinner's oil not fatten my head, because still my prayer also is in their good pleasures.

6 Their judges were swallowed up beside a rock; they will hear my words, because they became sweet.

7 Like a thickness of earth was torn apart upon the earth, our bones were scattered beside Hades.

8 Because toward you, Lord, Lord, are my eyes; in you I hoped; do not take away my soul.

9 Guard me from a snare which they set for me, and from the stumbling blocks of those who work lawlessness.

10 Sinners will fall in his net; I am alone until I pass by.

Chapter 141

1 Of understanding, for Dauid when he was in the cave; a prayer.

2 With my voice I cried to the Lord; with my voice I supplicated the Lord.

3 I shall pour out my supplication before him; I shall announce my affliction before him.

4 When my spirit failed from me, you also knew my paths; on this way in which I was walking they hid a snare for me.

5 I was observing toward the right and looking, because there was no one who recognized me; escape perished from me, and there is no one who seeks out my soul.

6 I cried to you, Lord; I said, You are my hope, my portion in the land of the living.

7 Attend to my supplication, because I was greatly humbled; deliver me from those who pursue me, because they became mightier than I.

8 Bring my soul out of prison to acknowledge your name, Lord; the righteous will wait for me until you repay me.

Chapter 142

1 A psalm for Dauid, when the son pursues him. Lord, hear my prayer; listen to my supplication in your truth; hear me in your righteousness;

2 and do not enter into judgment with your slave, because no one living will be justified before you.

3 Because the enemy pursued my soul, he humbled my life to the earth; he seated me in dark places like the dead of an age;

4 and my spirit grew despondent upon me; my heart was troubled within me.

5 I remembered ancient days and meditated on all your works; on the things made by your hands I was meditating.

6 I spread out my hands toward you; my soul is like a waterless land to you. Interlude.

7 Hear me quickly, Lord; my spirit failed; do not turn your face away from me, and I shall be made like those descending into a pit.

8 Make your mercy heard by me in the morning, because in you I hoped; make known to me, Lord, a way in which I shall walk, because to you I lifted my soul;

9 rescue me from my enemies, Lord, because to you I fled for refuge.

10 Teach me to do your will, because you are my God; your good spirit will lead me on level land.

11 For the sake of your name, Lord, you will give me life; in your righteousness you will bring my soul out of affliction;

12 and in your mercy you will utterly destroy my enemies and destroy all who afflict my soul; because I am your slave.

Chapter 143

1 For Dauid, against Goliad. Blessed is the Lord my God, who teaches my hands for battle array, my fingers for war;

2 my mercy and my refuge, my helper and my deliverer, my defender, and in him I hoped, he who subjects my people under me.

3 Lord, what is a human, that you became known to him, or a son of a human, that you reckon him?

4 A human was made like vanity; his days pass by like a shadow.

5 Lord, incline your heavens and descend; touch the mountains, and they will smoke;

6 flash a lightning, and you will scatter them; send out your arrows, and you will throw them into confusion.

7 Send out your hand from on high; rescue me and deliver me from many waters, from the hand of foreign sons,

8 whose mouth spoke vanity, and their right hand is a right hand of injustice.

9 God, I shall sing a new song to you; on a ten-stringed psaltery I shall sing to you,

10 who gives salvation to kings, who redeems Dauid his slave from an evil sword.

11 Deliver me and rescue me from the hand of foreign sons, whose mouth spoke vanity, and their right hand is a right hand of injustice.

12 Whose sons are like new plants grown strong in their youth, their daughters beautified, adorned all around like the likeness of a temple,

13 their storehouses full, pouring out from this into that, their sheep bearing many young, multiplying in their exits,

14 their oxen fat; there is no falling of a fence, nor a passage out, nor a cry in their squares.

15 They called blessed the people who have these things; blessed are the people whose God is the Lord.

Chapter 144

1 Praise for Dauid. I shall exalt you, my God, my king, and bless your name unto the age and unto the age of the age.

2 Every day I shall bless you and praise your name unto the age and unto the age of the age.

3 Great is the Lord and exceedingly praiseworthy, and there is no limit to his greatness.

4 Generation and generation will praise your works, and they will announce your power.

5 They will speak the magnificence of the glory of your holiness, and recount your marvelous things.

6 And they will tell the power of your fearful things, and recount your greatness.

7 They will pour forth a remembrance of the abundance of your kindness, and exult in your righteousness.

8 Compassionate and merciful is the Lord, long-suffering and abundant in mercy.

9 The Lord is kind to all, and his compassions are upon all his works.

10 Let all your works acknowledge you, Lord, and let your holy ones bless you.

11 They will tell the glory of your kingdom, and speak your might,

12 to make known to the sons of humans your might and the glory of the magnificence of your kingdom.

13 Your kingdom is a kingdom of all the ages, and your dominion is in every generation and generation.

13 a The Lord is faithful in his words, and holy in all his works.

14 The Lord supports all who fall and sets upright all who are cast down.

15 The eyes of all hope in you, and you give their food at a fitting time.

16 You open your hand and fill every living creature with good pleasure.

17 The Lord is righteous in all his ways, and holy in all his works.

18 The Lord is near to all who call upon him, to all who call upon him in truth.

19 He will do the will of those who fear him, and hear their supplication and save them.

20 The Lord guards all who love him, and will utterly destroy all the sinners.

21 My mouth will speak praise of the Lord, and let all flesh bless his holy name unto the age and unto the age of the age.

Chapter 145

1 Alleluia; of Aggaios and Zacharias. Praise the Lord, my soul.

2 I shall praise the Lord in my life; I shall sing to my God as long as I exist.

3 Do not trust in rulers and in sons of humans, in whom there is no salvation.

4 His spirit will go out, and he will return to his earth; on that day all their reasonings will perish.

5 Blessed is he whose helper is the God of Iakob, whose hope is in the Lord his God,

6 who made heaven and earth, the sea and all things in them, who guards truth unto the age,

7 who executes judgment for those wronged, who gives food to the hungry; the Lord releases those bound in fetters;

8 the Lord sets upright those cast down; the Lord makes the blind wise; the Lord loves the righteous;

9 the Lord guards the proselytes; he will take up orphan and widow, and will obliterate the way of sinners.

10 The Lord will reign unto the age, your God, Sion, unto generation and generation.

Chapter 146

1 Alleluia; of Aggaios and Zacharias. Praise the Lord, because a psalm is a good thing; may praise be made sweet to our God.

2 The Lord is building Ierousalem, and will gather together the dispersions of Israel,

3 he who heals those broken in heart and binds their fractures,

4 he who numbers multitudes of stars and calls names for all of them.

5 Great is our Lord, and great is his strength, and there is no number to his understanding.

6 The Lord takes up the meek, but humbles sinners to the earth.

7 Begin a song to the Lord with acknowledgment; sing to our God on a lyre,

8 to him who clothes heaven with clouds, who prepares rain for the earth, who causes grass to spring up on mountains [and green herbage for the service of humans,]

9 who gives the beasts their food, and the young of the ravens who call upon him.

10 He will not take pleasure in the might of the horse, nor does he delight in the shins of the man;

11 the Lord delights in those who fear him and in those who hope in his mercy.

Chapter 147

1 Alleluia; of Aggaios and Zacharias. Praise the Lord, Ierousalem; praise your God, Sion,

2 because he strengthened the bars of your gates; he blessed your sons within you;

3 he who makes your borders peace and fills you with fat of wheat;

4 he who sends his oracle to the earth; his word will run with speed,

5 the word of him who gives snow like wool, who sprinkles mist like ash,

6 who casts his ice like morsels; before the face of his cold, who will stand?

7 He will send his word and melt them; his wind will blow, and waters will flow.

8 He announces his word to Iakob, his ordinances and judgments to Israel.

9 He did not do thus to every nation, and he did not make his judgments clear to them.

Chapter 148

1 Alleluia; of Aggaios and Zacharias. Praise the Lord from the heavens; praise him in the highest places.

2 Praise him, all his angels; praise him, all his powers.

3 Praise him, sun and moon; praise him, all the stars and the light.

4 Praise him, heavens of the heavens, and the water above the heavens.

5 Let them praise the name of the Lord, because he spoke, and they came to be; he commanded, and they were created.

6 He established them unto the age and unto the age of the age; he set a command, and it will not pass away.

7 Praise the Lord from the earth, dragons and all abysses;

8 fire, hail, snow, ice, storm wind, which do his word;

9 mountains and all hills, fruit-bearing trees and all cedars;

10 wild beasts and all cattle, creeping things and winged birds;

11 kings of the earth and all peoples, rulers and all judges of the earth;

12 young men and virgins, old men with younger ones;

13 let them praise the name of the Lord, because the name of him alone was exalted; his acknowledgment is upon earth and heaven.

14 And he will exalt a horn of his people; a hymn for all his holy ones, for the sons of Israel, a people drawing near to him.

Chapter 149

1 Alleluia. Sing a new song to the Lord; his praise is in an assembly of holy ones.

2 Let Israel rejoice in him who made him, and let the sons of Sion exult in their king;

3 let them praise his name in a dance; on a tambourine and psaltery let them sing to him,

4 because the Lord delights in his people and will exalt the meek in salvation.

5 Holy ones will boast in glory and exult upon their beds;

6 the exaltations of God are in their throat, and two-edged swords in their hands,

7 to execute vengeance among the nations, reproofs among the peoples,

8 to bind their kings in fetters and their glorious ones in iron handcuffs,

9 to execute among them a written judgment; this glory is for all his holy ones.

Chapter 150

1 Alleluia. Praise God in his holy places; praise him in the firmament of his power;

2 praise him for his mighty deeds; praise him according to the abundance of his greatness.

3 Praise him with a trumpet's sound; praise him on a psaltery and lyre;

4 praise him with a tambourine and dance; praise him with strings and an instrument;

5 praise him with well-sounding cymbals; praise him with cymbals of a shout.

6 Let every breath praise the Lord. Alleluia.

Chapter 151

1 This psalm is written in his own hand, concerning Dauid, and outside the number; when he fought Goliad in single combat. I was small among my brothers and younger in my father's house; I was shepherding my father's sheep.

2 My hands made an instrument; my fingers fitted together a psaltery.

3 And who will announce to my Lord? He himself is Lord; he himself hears.

4 He himself sent out his angel and took me from my father's sheep, and anointed me with the oil of his anointing.

5 My brothers were beautiful and great, and the Lord did not delight in them.

6 I went out to meet the foreigner, and he cursed me by his idols;

7 but I, drawing the sword from him, beheaded him and removed reproach from the sons of Israel. – –

Odes

Chapter 1

1 t A song of Moyses in Exodus.

1 LET US SING to the Lord, for he has been gloriously glorified; horse and rider he threw into the sea.

2 He became a helper and shelterer to me for salvation; this is my God, and I shall glorify him, the God of my father, and I shall exalt him.

3 The Lord shatters wars; Lord is his name.

4 Pharao's chariots and his force he threw into the sea; chosen riders, officers of the third rank, he drowned in the Red Sea;

5 he covered them with the sea; they sank into the depth like a stone.

6 Your right hand, Lord, has been glorified in strength; your right hand, Lord, shattered enemies.

7 And by the abundance of your glory you shattered the adversaries; you sent out your wrath, and it devoured them like stubble.

8 And through the breath of your anger the water parted; the waters congealed like a wall; the waves congealed in the midst of the sea.

9 The enemy said, Pursuing, I shall overtake; I shall divide spoils; I shall fill my soul; I shall kill with my sword; my hand will rule.

10 You sent out your wind; the sea covered them; they sank like lead in violent water.

11 Who is like you among gods, Lord? Who is like you, glorified among holy ones, marvelous in glories, doing wonders?

12 You stretched out your right hand, and the earth swallowed them.

13 With your righteousness you led this people of yours whom you redeemed; with your strength you encouraged them toward your holy lodging.

14 Nations heard and were angered; pangs seized those dwelling in Phylistiim.

15 Then leaders of Edom hastened, and rulers of the Moabites; trembling seized them; all who dwell in Chanaan melted.

16 May fear and trembling fall upon them; by the greatness of your arm let them be turned to stone, until your people pass through, Lord, until this people of yours whom you acquired pass through.

17 Bring them in and plant them on a mountain of your inheritance, in your prepared dwelling which you made, Lord, a sanctuary, Lord, which your hands prepared.

18 The Lord reigns for the age and unto an age and still further.

19 Because Pharao's horse entered the sea with chariots and riders, and the Lord brought upon them the water of the sea; but the sons of Israel walked through dry land in the midst of the sea.

Chapter 2

1 t A song of Moyses in Deuteronomy.

1 ATTEND, heaven, and I shall speak, and let earth hear words from my mouth.

2 Let my utterance be awaited like rain, and let my words descend like dew, like a shower upon grass and like snowfall upon herbage.

3 Because I called the name of the Lord; give greatness to our God.

4 God, his works are true, and all his ways are judgment; a faithful God, and there is no injustice; righteous and holy is the Lord.

5 Blameworthy children sinned, not against him, a crooked and perverted generation.

6 Do you thus repay these things to the Lord, foolish and unwise people? Did not this one himself, your father, acquire you and make you and create you?

7 Remember days of an age; understand years of a generation of generations; ask your father, and he will announce to you, your elders, and they will tell you.

8 When the Most High was dividing nations, as he scattered sons of Adam, he set boundaries of nations according to the number of angels of God,

9 and his people Iakob became the Lord's portion, Israel the measured allotment of his inheritance.

10 He made him sufficient in the wilderness, in thirst of burning heat in a waterless place; he surrounded him and disciplined him and guarded him like the pupil of an eye,

11 like an eagle to shelter its nest, and he yearned over his nestlings; spreading his wings, he received them and took them up upon his back.

12 The Lord alone led them, and there was no foreign god with them.

13 He brought them up upon the strength of the earth; he fed them produce of fields; they sucked honey from rock and oil from solid rock,

14 butter of cattle and milk of sheep with fat of lambs and rams, offspring of bulls and goats, with fat of kidneys of wheat; and they drank blood of a grape as wine.

15 And Iakob ate and was filled, and the beloved one kicked away; he grew fat, grew thick, grew broad; and he forsook God who made him and departed from God his savior.

16 They provoked me over foreign things; with their abominations they embittered me;

17 they sacrificed to demons and not to God, to gods whom they did not know; new and recent ones have come whom their fathers did not know.

18 You forsook God who begot you, and forgot God who nourishes you.

19 And the Lord saw and grew jealous and was provoked because of the wrath of his sons and daughters,

20 and said, I shall turn my face away from them and show what will happen to them at the last; because it is a perverted generation, sons in whom there is no faith.

21 They made me jealous over what is no god; they angered me with their idols; and I shall make them jealous over what is no nation; over a nation without understanding I shall anger them.

22 Because a fire has been kindled from my anger, it will burn down to Hades below, devour earth and its produce, set ablaze foundations of mountains.

23 I shall gather evils upon them, and expend my arrows upon them.

24 Wasting away with hunger and the devouring of birds, and incurable backward convulsion; I shall send out upon them teeth of wild beasts, with the fury of things crawling upon earth.

25 Outside, a sword will bereave them, and from the chambers, fear; a young man with a virgin, a suckling with an established elder.

26 I said, I shall scatter them; I shall indeed put an end to their memorial among humans,

27 were it not for the wrath of enemies, so that they may not last long, and so that the adversaries may not attack together, lest they say, Our hand is high, and the Lord did not do all these things.

28 Because it is a nation that has lost counsel, and there is no knowledge among them.

29 They did not take thought to understand these things; let them receive them for the coming time.

30 How will one pursue a thousand, and two move tens of thousands, unless God sold them and the Lord handed them over?

31 For their gods are not like our God; but our enemies are senseless.

32 For their vine is from a vine of Sodoma, and their vine branch from Gomorra; their grape is a grape of gall, a cluster of bitterness for them;

33 their wine is the venom of dragons and the incurable venom of asps.

34 Behold, have not all these things been gathered with me and sealed in my treasuries?

35 On a day of vengeance I shall repay, at a time when their foot slips; because the day of their destruction is near, and things prepared for you are present.

36 Because the Lord will judge his people, and concerning his slaves he will be comforted; for he saw them enfeebled and failing under attack and slackened.

37 And the Lord said, Where are their gods, in whom they had trusted,

38 whose fat of their sacrifices you were eating and whose wine of their libations you were drinking? Let them rise and help you and become shelterers for you.

39 See, see that I am, and there is no god except me; I shall kill and make alive; I shall strike, and I shall heal; and there is no one who will rescue from my hands.

40 Because I shall lift my hand to heaven and swear by my right hand and say, I live unto the age,

41 because I shall sharpen my sword like lightning, and my hand will hold fast to judgment, and I shall repay justice to the enemies, and to those who hate me I shall repay;

42 I shall make my arrows drunk with blood, and my sword will devour flesh, from the blood of wounded ones and captivity, from the head of rulers of nations.

43 Rejoice, heavens, together with him, and let all the angels of God bow down to him; rejoice, nations, with his people, and let all sons of God strengthen themselves for him; because the blood of his sons is avenged, and he will avenge and repay justice to the enemies, and repay those who hate, and the Lord will cleanse the land of his people.

Chapter 3

1 t A prayer of Anna, mother of Samouel.

1 MY HEART WAS STRENGTHENED in the Lord; my horn was exalted in my God; my mouth was widened against my enemies; I rejoiced in your salvation.

2 Because there is no holy one like the Lord, and there is no righteous one like our God; there is no holy one except you.

3 Do not boast and do not speak lofty things, nor let grand speech come out of your mouth, because the Lord is a God of knowledge, and God prepares his practices.

4 The bow of mighty ones grew weak, and those who are weak girded themselves with strength;

5 those full of bread were diminished, and the hungry left the land; because a barren woman bore seven, and she who was abundant in children grew weak.

6 The Lord puts to death and brings to life, brings down to Hades and brings up;

7 the Lord makes poor and makes rich, humbles and lifts up.

8 He raises a needy one from earth and lifts a poor one from a dung heap, to seat him with rulers of a people, and assigns a throne of glory to them as an inheritance.

9 Giving a prayer to the one who prays, and he blessed the years of a righteous one; because a man is not mighty by strength,

10 the Lord will make his adversary weak; the Lord is holy. Let the wise one not boast in his wisdom, and let the mighty one not boast in his might, and let the rich one not boast in his riches, but let him who boasts boast only in this: to understand and know the Lord, and to do judgment and righteousness in the midst of the earth. The Lord went up into heavens and thundered; he himself will judge the ends of earth, being righteous, and gives strength to our kings, and will exalt the horn of his anointed one.

Chapter 4

1 t A prayer of Ionas.

1 I CRIED in my affliction to the Lord my God, and he heard my cry from the belly of Hades; you heard my voice.

2 You cast me into depths of the heart of the sea, and rivers surrounded me; all your billows and your waves passed over me.

3 And I said, I have been thrust away from your eyes; shall I again look toward your holy temple?

4 Water poured around me as far as my soul; the utmost abyss surrounded me; my head sank into clefts of mountains.

5 I descended into a land whose bars are eternal restraints, and let my life ascend from corruption, Lord my God.

6 When my soul failed from me, I remembered the Lord, and may my prayer come to you, into your holy temple.

7 Those who guard vain and false things forsook their mercy.

8 But I shall sacrifice to you with a voice of praise and acknowledgment; whatever I vowed, I shall repay you for my salvation, to the Lord.

Chapter 5

1 t A song of Esaias.

1 I SHALL SING, then, to the beloved one a song of the loved one for my vineyard; a vineyard came to be for the beloved one on a horn, in a fertile place,

2 and I put a fence around it and planted a vine in Sorek and built a tower in its midst and dug a wine-vat in it; and I waited for it to produce a grape, but it produced thorns.

3 And now, person of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierousalem, judge between me and my vineyard.

4 What shall I yet do to my vineyard that I did not do to it? Because I waited for it to produce a grape, but it produced thorns.

5 But now I shall announce to you what I shall do to my vineyard; I shall remove its fence, and it will be for plunder, and I shall tear down its wall, and it will be for trampling,

6 and I shall abandon my vineyard, and it will certainly not be pruned nor dug, and thorns will come up into it as into waste land, and I shall command the clouds not to rain rain upon it.

7 For the vineyard of the Lord Sabaoth is the house of Israel, and a person of Iouda a beloved new plant, and I waited for it to do judgment, but it did lawlessness, and not righteousness, but a cry.

8 Woe to those who join house to house and bring field near to field, so that they may take away their neighbor's property; will you dwell alone upon the earth?

9 For all these things were heard in the ears of the Lord Sabaoth.

Chapter 6

1 t A prayer of Esaias.

1 FROM NIGHT my spirit rises early toward you, God, because your commands are light upon the earth; learn righteousness, you who dwell upon the earth.

2 For the ungodly one has ceased; he will certainly not learn righteousness upon the earth; he will certainly not do truth; let the ungodly one be removed, so that he may not see the glory of the Lord.

3 Lord, your arm is high, and they did not know, but having known, let them be ashamed; zeal will seize an undisciplined people, and now fire will devour the adversaries.

4 Lord our God, give us peace; for you repaid all things to us.

5 Lord our God, acquire us; Lord, apart from you we know no other; we name your name.

6 But the dead will certainly not see life, nor will physicians certainly raise them; because of this you brought calamity and destroyed and removed every male of theirs.

7 Add evils to them, Lord; add evils to the glorious ones of the earth.

8 Lord, in affliction I remembered you; in small affliction your discipline is for us.

9 And as she who is in labor draws near to giving birth and cries out in her pang, so we became to your beloved one.

10 Because of your fear, Lord, we conceived in the womb and labored and gave birth; we made a spirit of your salvation upon the earth; we shall not fall, but those dwelling upon the earth will fall.

11 The dead will rise, and those in the tombs will be raised, and those in the earth will rejoice; for the dew from you is a healing for them, but the land of the ungodly will fall.

12 Go, my people, enter your chambers, shut your door, hide yourself for a little while, until the wrath of the Lord passes by.

Chapter 7

1 t A prayer of Ezekias.

1 I said, At the height of my days I shall go in the gates of Hades; I shall leave behind the remaining years.

2 I said, No longer shall I see the salvation of God upon the earth; I shall certainly not see a human among those dwelling.

3 I failed from my kindred; I left behind the rest of my life; it went out and departed from me like one who takes down a tent after pitching it; my spirit within me became like a web, with a weaving woman drawing near to cut it off.

4 On that day I was handed over until morning as to a lion; thus he shattered all my bones; for from day until night I was handed over.

5 Like a swallow, so I shall utter a sound, and like a dove, so I shall murmur; for my eyes failed from looking to the height of heaven toward the Lord,

6 who rescued me and removed from me the pain of my soul.

7 Lord, for concerning it an announcement was made to you, and you roused my breath, and being comforted, I lived;

8 for you chose my soul, so that it may not perish, and cast behind me all my sins.

9 For those in Hades will not praise you, nor will those who died bless you, nor will those in Hades hope in your mercy;

10 the living will bless you, as I also do. For from today I shall make children who will announce your righteousness, Lord of my salvation,

11 and I shall not cease blessing you with a psaltery all the days of my life before the house of God.

Chapter 8

1 t A prayer of Manasse.

1 LORD almighty, God of our fathers, of Abraam and Isaak and Iakob and of their righteous seed,

2 who made heaven and earth with all their adornment,

3 who fettered the sea by the word of your command, who shut the abyss and sealed it with your fearful and glorious name;

4 whom all things shudder at and tremble before the face of your power,

5 because the magnificence of your glory is unbearable, and the wrath of your threat against sinners cannot be withstood,

6 and the mercy of your promise is immeasurable and unsearchable,

7 because you are Lord Most High, compassionate, long-suffering and abundant in mercy, and repenting over the evils of humans;

8 you, therefore, Lord, God of the righteous, did not set repentance for the righteous, for Abraam and Isaak and Iakob, who have not sinned against you, but you set repentance for me the sinner,

9 because I sinned beyond the number of sand of the sea; my lawless deeds multiplied, Lord, multiplied, and I am not worthy to gaze and see the height of heaven because of the abundance of my injustices,

10 bent down by a great bond of iron, to lift my head on account of my sins, and there is no relief for me, because I provoked your anger and did evil before you, setting up abominations and multiplying offenses.

11 And now I bend the knee of my heart, begging for the kindness from you:

12 I have sinned, Lord, I have sinned, and I know my lawless deeds.

13 I ask, begging you, Release me, Lord, release me; do not destroy me together with my lawless deeds, nor, being angry unto the age, keep evils for me, nor condemn me in the lowest parts of the earth. Because you are, Lord, the God of those who repent,

14 and may you show your goodness in me; because, though I am unworthy, you will save me according to your abundant mercy,

15 and I shall praise you continually in the days of my life. Because all the power of the heavens hymns you, and yours is the glory unto the ages. Amen.

Chapter 9

1 t A prayer of Ambakoum.

1 LORD, I have heard your report and was afraid; I considered your works and was astonished. In the midst of two living creatures you will be known; when the years draw near you will be recognized; when the time is present you will be shown forth; when my soul is troubled, in wrath you will remember mercy.

2 God will come from Thaiman, and the Holy One from Mount Pharan, shaded and thickly wooded. Interlude. His excellence covered heavens, and the earth is full of his praise.

3 And his radiance will be like light, horns in his hands, and he set a mighty love of his strength.

4 A word will go before his face, and he will go out, his feet in sandals.

5 He stood, and the earth was shaken; he looked, and nations melted. The mountains were shattered by force; eternal hills melted.

6 I saw his eternal paths in place of toils; dwellings of Ethiopians will be terrified, and the tents of the land of Madiam.

7 Were you angered at rivers, Lord, or was your anger at rivers, or your onrush at the sea? Because you will mount your horses, and your riding is salvation.

8 Stretching, you will stretch your bow against scepters, says the Lord. Interlude. Earth will be broken open by rivers.

9 Peoples will see you and be in labor. Scattering waters of a passage; the abyss gave its voice; the height of its apparition was raised.

10 The sun and the moon stood in her station; your missiles will go into light, into the radiance of the lightning of your weapons.

11 With your threat you will diminish earth, and with anger you will bring down nations.

12 You went out for the salvation of your people, to save your anointed ones; you cast death upon heads of lawless ones; you raised bonds as far as the neck. Interlude.

13 You cut through heads of rulers in astonishment; they will be shaken in it; they will open their bridles like a poor one eating secretly.

14 And you drove your horses into the sea, troubling many waters.

15 I kept watch, and my belly was terrified at the voice of the prayer of my lips, and trembling entered my bones, and beneath me my condition was troubled. I shall rest on the day of my affliction, to go up to a people of my sojourning.

16 Because a fig tree will not bear fruit, and there will be no produce on the vines; the work of an olive tree will prove false, and the plains will not produce food; sheep failed from lack of food, and oxen do not exist at the mangers of their propitiation.

17 But I shall exult in the Lord; I shall rejoice in God my savior.

18 The Lord my God is my strength, and will set my feet for completion; upon the high places he brings me up, to conquer in his song.

Chapter 10

1 t A prayer of Azarias.

1 BLESSED are you, Lord, God of our fathers, and praiseworthy and glorified is your name unto the ages,

2 because you are righteous in all things you did to us, and all your works are true, and your ways upright, and all your judgments true,

3 and you executed judgments of truth in all things you brought upon us, and upon the holy city of our fathers, Ierousalem, because in truth and judgment you brought all these things because of our sins.

4 Because we sinned and acted lawlessly in departing from you, and sinned in all things, and did not hear your commandments,

5 nor kept them nor did as you commanded us, so that it may be well with us.

6 And all things you brought upon us, and all things you did to us, you did in true judgment,

7 and handed us over into hands of lawless enemies, most hateful apostates, and to a king unjust and most evil beyond all the earth.

8 And now it is not possible for us to open our mouth; shame and reproach came upon your slaves and those who revere you.

9 Do not, then, hand us over to the end, for the sake of your name, and do not scatter your covenant,

10 and do not remove your mercy from us, for the sake of Abraam who was loved by you, and for the sake of Isaak your slave and Israel your holy one,

11 to whom you spoke, saying that you would multiply their seed like the stars of heaven and like the sand by the lip of the sea.

12 Because, Master, we were made smaller than all the nations, and are lowly in all the earth today because of our sins,

13 and at this time there is no ruler and prophet and leader, nor a whole burnt offering nor sacrifice nor offering nor incense, no place to offer firstfruits before you and find mercy.

14 But with a broken soul and a spirit of humility may we be received, as with whole burnt offerings of rams and bulls and as with tens of thousands of fat lambs;

15 thus let our sacrifice be before you today, and let us follow after you completely, because there is no shame for those who trust in you.

16 And now we follow with a whole heart and fear you and seek your face; do not put us to shame,

17 but act with us according to your gentleness and according to the abundance of your mercy,

18 and rescue us according to your marvelous things and give glory to your name, Lord.

19 And may all who show evils to your slaves be abashed, and may they be put to shame from all power and might, and may their strength be shattered,

20 and let them know that you are Lord, the only God, and glorious over the whole inhabited world.

Chapter 11

1 t A hymn of the three children.

1 BLESSED are you, Lord, God of our fathers, and praiseworthy and exalted above all unto the ages, and blessed is the holy name of your glory, and praised above all and exalted above all unto the ages.

2 Blessed are you in the temple of your holy glory, and hymned above all and glorious above all unto the ages.

3 Blessed are you, who see abysses, seated upon cheroubin, and praised above all and exalted above all unto the ages.

4 Blessed are you upon the throne of your kingdom, and hymned above all and exalted above all unto the ages.

5 Blessed are you in the firmament of heaven, and hymned above all and glorious above all unto the ages.

6 Bless the Lord, all works of the Lord; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

7 Bless the Lord, angels of the Lord; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

8 Bless the Lord, heavens; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

9 Bless the Lord, all waters above the heavens; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

10 Bless the Lord, all powers of the Lord; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

11 Bless the Lord, sun and moon; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

12 Bless the Lord, stars of heaven; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

13 Bless the Lord, every shower and dew; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

14 Bless the Lord, all winds; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

15 Bless the Lord, fire and burning heat; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

16 Bless the Lord, cold and scorching heat; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

17 Bless the Lord, dews and snowfalls; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

18 Bless the Lord, frost and cold; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

19 Bless the Lord, hoarfrosts and snows; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

20 Bless the Lord, nights and days; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

21 Bless the Lord, light and darkness; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

22 Bless the Lord, lightnings and clouds; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

23 Let the earth bless the Lord; let it hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

24 Bless the Lord, mountains and hills; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

25 Bless the Lord, all things growing in the earth; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

26 Bless the Lord, springs; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

27 Bless the Lord, seas and rivers; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

28 Bless the Lord, sea monsters and all things moving in the waters; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

29 Bless the Lord, all birds of heaven; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

30 Bless the Lord, wild beasts and all cattle; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

31 Bless the Lord, sons of humans; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

32 Let Israel bless the Lord; let him hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

33 Bless the Lord, priests of the Lord; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

34 Bless the Lord, slaves of the Lord; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

35 Bless the Lord, spirits and souls of the righteous; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

36 Bless the Lord, holy ones and humble in heart; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

37 Bless the Lord, Ananias, Azarias, Misael; hymn and exalt him above all unto the ages.

Chapter 12

1 t A prayer of Maria the God-bearer.

1 MY SOUL MAGNIFIES the Lord,

2 and my spirit exulted in God my savior,

3 because he looked upon the lowliness of his female slave; for behold, from now all generations will call me blessed,

4 because the Mighty One did great things for me, and holy is his name,

5 and his mercy is unto generation and generation for those who fear him.

6 He did strength with his arm; he scattered the arrogant in the thought of their heart;

7 he brought down rulers from thrones and exalted the lowly;

8 he filled the hungry with good things and sent the rich away empty.

9 He took hold of Israel his servant, to remember mercy,

10 as he spoke to our fathers, to Abraam and to his seed unto an age.

Chapter 13

1 t A prayer of Zacharias.

1 BLESSED is the Lord, the God of Israel, because he visited and effected redemption for his people,

2 and raised a horn of salvation for us in the house of Dauid his servant,

3 as he spoke through the mouth of his holy prophets from an age,

4 salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all who hate us,

5 to do mercy with our fathers and remember his holy covenant,

6 an oath which he swore to Abraam our father,

7 to grant us, delivered from the hand of our enemies, fearlessly

8 to serve him in holiness and righteousness before him all our days.

9 And you also, child, will be called a prophet of the Most High; for you will go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways,

10 to give knowledge of salvation to his people in forgiveness of our sins,

11 through the bowels of mercy of our God, in which a rising from on high visited us,

12 to shine upon those sitting in darkness and the shadow of death, to direct our feet into a way of peace.

Chapter 14

1 t A prayer of Symeon.

1 NOW you release your slave, Master, according to your word, in peace,

2 because my eyes saw your salvation,

3 which you prepared before the face of all the peoples,

4 a light for revelation of nations and glory of your people Israel.

Chapter 15

1 t A morning hymn.

1 GLORY to God in the highest places,

2 and upon earth peace,

3 among humans good pleasure.

4 We praise you,

5 we bless you,

6 we bow down to you,

7 we glorify you,
8 we give thanks to you
9 because of your great glory,
10 Lord king,
11 heavenly one,
12 God, Father almighty,
13 Lord, only-begotten Son,
14 Jesus Christ,
15 and Holy Spirit.
16 Lord God,
17 the Lamb of God,
18 the Son of the Father,
19 who takes away the sins of the world,
20 have mercy on us;
21 who takes away the sins of the world,
22 receive our supplication;
23 who sits at the right hand of the Father,
24 have mercy on us.
25 Because you alone are holy,
26 you alone are Lord,
27 Jesus Christ,
28 unto the glory of God the Father. Amen.
29 Every day I shall bless you,
30 and praise your name unto the age
31 and unto the age of the age.
32 Deem us worthy, Lord, on this day also,
33 to be guarded without sin.
34 Blessed are you, Lord, God of our fathers,
35 and praiseworthy and glorified is your name unto the ages. Amen.
36 Blessed are you, Lord; teach me your ordinances;
37 blessed are you, Lord; teach me your ordinances;
38 blessed are you, Lord; teach me your ordinances.
39 Lord, you became a refuge for us in generation and generation.

40 I said, Lord, have mercy on me,
41 heal my soul, because I sinned against you.
42 Lord, to you I fled for refuge;
43 teach me to do your will, because you are my God;
44 because with you is a fountain of life,
45 in your light we shall see light;
46 extend your mercy to those who know you.

Proverbs

Chapter 1

1 Proverbs of Salomon, son of Dauid, who reigned in Israel,

2 to know wisdom and discipline, and to understand words of prudence,

3 and to receive turns of words, and to understand true righteousness and direct judgment,

4 so that he may give shrewdness to the innocent, and perception and thought to a young child;

5 for a wise one who hears these things will be wiser, and the understanding one will acquire guidance,

6 and will understand a parable and a dark saying, sayings of the wise and riddles.

7 The beginning of wisdom is fear of God, and understanding is good for all who practice it; reverence toward God is the beginning of perception, but the ungodly will despise wisdom and discipline.

8 Hear, son, your father's discipline, and do not thrust away your mother's ordinances;

9 for you will receive a crown of graces for your head and a golden collar around your neck.

10 Son, let ungodly men not lead you astray, nor consent if they exhort you, saying,

11 Come with us, share in blood, and let us hide a righteous man unjustly in the earth,

12 and let us swallow him alive like Hades, and remove his memory from the earth;

13 let us seize his costly possession, and fill our houses with spoils;

14 cast your lot among us, and let us all acquire a common purse, and let there be one pouch for us.

15 Do not walk on a way with them, but turn your foot aside from their paths;

16 for their feet run toward evil, and are swift to shed blood;

17 for nets are not unjustly spread for winged creatures.

18 For those who share in murder themselves store up evils for themselves, and the overthrow of lawless men is evil.

19 These are the ways of all who carry out lawless things; for by ungodliness they take away their own soul.

20 Wisdom is hymned at exits, and in squares she practices frank speech,

21 and on the tops of walls she is proclaimed, and at rulers' gates she sits beside them, and at city gates she confidently says,

22 As long as the innocent hold fast to righteousness, they will not be ashamed; but the foolish, being desirers of insolence, became ungodly and hated perception,

23 and became liable to reproofs. Behold, I shall send forth to you an utterance of my breath, and teach you my word.

24 Since I was calling and you did not obey, and I was extending words and you did not attend,

25 but you were rendering my counsels void, and disobeyed my reproofs,

26 therefore I also shall laugh at your destruction, and rejoice over you when ruin comes to you,

27 and when tumult reaches you suddenly, and overthrow is present like a storm, and when affliction and siege come to you, or when ruin comes to you.

28 For it will be when you call upon me, but I shall not hear you; evil ones will seek me and not find me.

29 For they hated wisdom, and did not choose the fear of the Lord,

30 nor wished to attend to my counsels, but were sneering at my reproofs.

31 Therefore they will eat the fruits of their own way, and be filled with their own ungodliness;

32 for in return for wronging infants they will be murdered, and examination will destroy the ungodly.

33 But the one who hears me will encamp in hope, and rest without fear from every evil.

Chapter 2

1 Son, if, receiving an utterance of my commandment, you hide it with yourself,

2 your ear will obey wisdom, and you will apply your heart to understanding, and apply it to admonition for your son.

3 For if you call upon wisdom and give your voice to understanding, and seek perception with a great voice,

4 and if you seek her like silver and search her out like treasures,

5 then you will understand fear of the Lord and find knowledge of God.

6 Because the Lord gives wisdom, and from his face come knowledge and understanding;

7 and he stores up salvation for those who act rightly; he will defend their journey,

8 to guard ways of ordinances, and he will preserve the way of those who revere him.

9 Then you will understand righteousness and judgment, and set straight all good tracks.

10 For if wisdom comes into your thought, and perception seems beautiful to your soul,

11 good counsel will guard you, and holy thought will keep you,

12 so that she may deliver you from an evil way and from a man who speaks nothing trustworthy.

13 O you who forsake straight ways to walk in ways of darkness,

14 who rejoice over evils and delight in evil perversity,

15 whose paths are crooked, and their tracks curved,

16 to make you far from a straight way and a stranger to righteous judgment.

17 Son, let evil counsel not overtake you, which leaves behind the teaching of youth and has forgotten a divine covenant;

18 for she set her house beside death, and her tracks beside Hades with the earthborn;

19 all who walk in her will not return, nor will they attain straight paths; for they are not overtaken by years of life.

20 For if they were walking good paths, they would have found smooth paths of righteousness.

21 The kind will be inhabitants of earth, and the innocent will remain in it, because the upright will encamp on earth, and the holy will remain in it;

22 ways of the ungodly will perish from earth, and the lawless will be thrust out of it.

Chapter 3

1 Son, do not forget my laws, and let your heart keep my words;

2 for they will add to you length of life and years of life and peace.

3 Let mercies and faithfulnesses not fail you, but fasten them upon your neck, and you will find grace;

4 and take thought for good things before the Lord and humans.

5 Be trusting in God with a whole heart, but do not be exalted over your own wisdom;

6 in all your ways make her known, so that she may cut your ways straight, [and your foot will certainly not stumble.]

7 Do not be prudent in your own estimation, but fear God and turn aside from every evil;

8 then there will be healing for your body and care for your bones.

9 Honor the Lord from your righteous labors, and offer firstfruits to him from your fruits of righteousness,

10 so that your storehouses may be filled with an abundance of grain, and your winepresses overflow with wine.

11 Son, do not make light of the Lord's discipline, nor grow faint when reproved by him;

12 for whom the Lord loves he disciplines, and he scourges every son whom he receives.

13 Blessed is a human who found wisdom, and a mortal who saw prudence;

14 for trading in her is better than treasures of gold and silver.

15 And she is more precious than costly stones; nothing evil will oppose her; she is well known to all who draw near to her, and everything precious is not worthy of her.

16 For length of life and years of life are in her right hand, and in her left hand riches and glory;

16 a From her mouth righteousness goes out, and she carries law and mercy upon her tongue.

17 Her ways are beautiful ways, and all her paths are in peace;

18 she is a tree of life to all who hold fast to her, and secure for those leaning upon her as upon the Lord.

19 God founded the earth by wisdom, and prepared heavens with prudence;

20 with perception abysses were broken open, and clouds flowed with dews.

21 Son, do not drift away, but keep my counsel and thought,

22 so that your soul may live, and grace be around your neck.

22 a And there will be healing for your flesh and care for your bones,

23 so that you may walk confidently in peace on all your ways, and your foot will certainly not stumble.

24 For if you sit, you will be fearless, and if you lie down, you will sleep pleasantly;

25 and you will not fear terror coming upon you, nor onrushes of ungodly ones coming upon you;

26 for the Lord will be upon all your ways, and will support your foot, so that you may not be shaken.

27 Do not withhold doing good to a needy one whenever your hand has the means to help;

28 do not say, Go away and return, and tomorrow I shall give, when you are able to do good; for you do not know what the coming day will bear.

29 Do not devise evils against your friend who sojourns and trusts in you.

30 Do not be hostile toward a human in vain, lest he do some evil to you.

31 Do not acquire reproaches of evil men, nor be jealous of their ways;

32 for every lawless one is unclean before the Lord, and he does not sit in council among the righteous.

33 God's curse is in houses of the ungodly, but dwellings of the righteous are blessed.

34 The Lord opposes the arrogant, but gives grace to the humble.

35 The wise will inherit glory, but the ungodly exalted dishonor.

Chapter 4

1 Hear, children, a father's discipline, and attend to know thought;

2 for I give you a good gift; do not forsake my law.

3 For I also became a son obedient to a father and loved before a mother's face,

4 who were saying and teaching me, Let our word be fixed in your heart;

5 guard commandments; do not forget nor overlook an utterance of my mouth,

6 nor forsake her, and she will hold fast to you; love her, and she will keep you;

8 fortify her, and she will exalt you; honor her, so that she may embrace you,

9 so that she may give your head a crown of graces, and defend you with a crown of delight.

10 Hear, son, and receive my words, and years of your life will be multiplied, so that there may be many ways of life for you;

11 for I teach you ways of wisdom, and set you on straight tracks.

12 For if you walk, your steps will not be confined; and if you run, you will not grow weary.

13 Take hold of my discipline; do not let go, but guard her for yourself for your life.

14 Do not enter ways of the ungodly, nor be jealous of ways of the lawless;

15 in whatever place they encamp, do not enter there, but turn aside from them and pass by.

16 For they will certainly not sleep unless they do evil; their sleep has been taken away, and they do not lie down;

17 for these feed on food of ungodliness, and become drunk with lawless wine.

18 But the ways of the righteous shine like light; they go forward and illuminate until the day comes fully right;

19 but the ways of the ungodly are dark; they do not know how they stumble.

20 Son, attend to my utterance, and apply your ear to my words,

21 so that your springs may not fail you; guard them in your heart;

22 for they are life to those who find them, and healing to all flesh.

23 With every guard keep your heart; for from these are exits of life.

24 Remove a crooked mouth from yourself, and thrust unjust lips far from you.

25 Let your eyes look straight, and let your eyelids incline toward righteous things.

26 Make straight tracks for your feet, and direct your ways.

27 Do not turn aside to the right or to the left, but turn your foot away from an evil way;

27 a For God knows the ways on the right, but those on the left are perverted;

28 and he himself will make your tracks straight, and lead your journeys forward in peace.

Chapter 5

1 Son, attend to my wisdom, and apply your ear to my words,

2 so that you may guard good thought; and I command you perception of my lips.

3 Do not attend to a worthless woman; for honey drips from a prostitute's lips, who for a time makes your throat smooth,

4 yet afterward you will find it more bitter than gall and sharpened more than a two-edged sword.

5 For the feet of folly bring those who use her down with death into Hades, and her footsteps are not firmly fixed;

6 for she does not enter ways of life, and her tracks are slippery and not well known.

7 Now therefore, son, hear me, and do not render my words void;

8 make your way far from her; do not draw near the doors of her houses,

9 so that you may not give away your life to others and your livelihood to the merciless,

10 so that strangers may not be filled with your strength, and your labors enter strangers' houses,

11 and you will regret it at the last, when the flesh of your body is worn away,

12 and say, How I hated discipline, and my heart turned aside from reproofs;

13 I was not hearing the voice of him who disciplined me, and was not applying my ear to him who taught me;

14 I came close to being in every evil in the midst of assembly and congregation.

15 Drink waters from your vessels and from your spring's wells.

16 Let the waters from your spring not overflow for you, but let your waters pass through your squares;

17 let them belong to you alone, and let no stranger share with you;

18 let your spring of water be your own, and rejoice together with the wife of your youth.

19 Let a deer of friendship and a foal of your graces consort with you, and let your own woman lead you and be with you at every time; for going about with her in her friendship, you will be greatly increased.

20 Do not be much with a foreign woman, nor be held in the embraces of one who is not your own;

21 for a man's ways are before God's eyes, and he observes all his tracks.

22 Lawless acts hunt a man, and each is bound tightly by cords of his own sins;

23 this one dies with the undisciplined, and from the abundance of his own livelihood he was cast out, and perished through folly.

Chapter 6

1 Son, if you become surety for your friend, you will hand your hand over to an enemy;

2 for a man's own lips are a strong snare, and he is caught by the lips of his own mouth.

3 Do, son, what I command you, and save yourself – for you have come into hands of evil ones through your friend – go without growing faint, and urge your friend also, for whom you became surety;

4 do not give sleep to your eyes, nor slumber with your eyelids,

5 so that you may be saved like a gazelle from nooses and like a bird from a snare.

6 Go to the ant, O sluggard, and seeing its ways, emulate it, and become wiser than it;

7 for though no cultivated field belongs to it, and it has no one compelling it, nor is under a master,

8 it prepares its food in summer, and makes abundant provision at harvest.

8 a Or go to the bee and learn how she is a worker, and how nobly she performs her work,

9 whose labors kings and private people take for health, and she is desired by all and held in esteem;

10 although weak in strength, having honored wisdom, she was advanced.

9 How long, sluggard, do you lie down? And when will you rise from sleep?

10 You sleep a little, and sit a little, and slumber a little, and embrace your chest with your hands a little;

11 then poverty comes upon you like an evil traveler, and need like a good runner.

11 a But if you are diligent, your harvest will come like a spring, and need will desert you like an evil runner.

12 A foolish and lawless man walks ways that are not good;

13 and he himself winks with an eye, signals with a foot, and teaches with gestures of fingers,

14 and with a perverted heart devises evils at every time; such a one sets up disturbances for a city.

15 Because of this his destruction comes suddenly, a breaking apart and incurable shattering.

16 Because he delights in all things the Lord hates, and is shattered through uncleanness of soul;

17 the eye of an insolent one, an unjust tongue, hands shedding a righteous one's blood,

18 and a heart devising evil reasonings, and feet hastening to do evil;

19 an unjust witness kindles lies, and sends disputes between brothers.

20 Son, guard your father's laws, and do not thrust away your mother's ordinances;

21 fasten them upon your soul continually, and hang them as a collar upon your neck.

22 Whenever you walk, bring her along, and let her be with you; and when you lie down, let her guard you, so that she may speak with you when you rise;

23 because a commandment of law is a lamp and light, and reproof and discipline are a way of life,

24 to preserve you from a married woman and from slander of a foreign tongue.

25 Let desire for beauty not conquer you, nor be hunted by your eyes, nor seized by her eyelids;

26 for a prostitute's price is as much as even one loaf, but a woman of men hunts precious souls.

27 Will someone bind fire in his bosom, yet not burn up his garments?

28 Or will someone walk upon coals of fire, yet not burn up his feet?

29 Thus the one who goes in to a married woman; he will not be acquitted, nor anyone who touches her.

30 It is not surprising if someone is caught stealing, for he steals to fill his soul when hungry;

31 but if he is caught, he will repay sevenfold, and giving all his possessions, will deliver himself.

32 But the adulterer, through lack of sense, procures destruction for his soul,

33 and bears pains and dishonors, and his reproach will not be erased unto the age.

34 For her husband's anger is full of jealousy; he will not spare on a day of judgment;

35 he will not exchange his enmity for any ransom, nor be reconciled by many gifts.

Chapter 7

1 Son, guard my words, and hide my commandments with yourself;

1 a Son, honor the Lord, and you will be strong, and apart from him fear no other.

2 Guard my commandments, and you will live, and my words like pupils of eyes;

3 put them around your fingers, and inscribe them upon the breadth of your heart.

4 Say that wisdom is your sister, and procure prudence as an acquaintance for yourself,

5 so that she may keep you from a foreign and evil woman, if she assails you with pleasing words.

6 For from a window of her house, peering out into the squares,

7 whatever young man among the foolish children she sees lacking sense,

8 passing by a corner in the passages of her houses,

9 and speaking in evening darkness, when the silence of night is gloomy,

10 the woman meets him, having a prostitute's appearance, who makes young men's hearts fly away.

11 And she is excited and prodigal, and her feet do not rest in a house;

12 for at one time she roams outside, and at another in squares she lies in wait beside every corner.

13 Then taking hold of him, she kissed him, and with a shameless face said to him,

14 I have a peace sacrifice; today I repay my vows;

15 because of this I came out to meet you; longing for your face, I have found you;

16 I have arranged my bed with bands, and spread it with double-sided coverings from Egypt;

17 I have sprinkled my couch with saffron, and my house with cinnamon;

18 come, and let us enjoy friendship until dawn; come here, and let us roll in love;

19 for my husband is not present in the house, but has gone on a long journey,

20 taking a bundle of silver in his hand; after many days he will return to his house.

21 And she led him astray with much conversation, and with nooses from her lips ran him aground.

22 And he followed her, made a fool, as an ox is led to slaughter, and as a dog to bonds,

23 or as a deer struck by an arrow in the liver, and he hastens like a bird into a snare, not knowing that he runs concerning his soul.

24 Now therefore, son, hear me, and attend to words of my mouth;

25 let your heart not incline to her ways;

26 for she has wounded and cast down many, and innumerable are those she has murdered;

27 her house is ways of Hades, leading down into the chambers of death.

Chapter 8

1 You will proclaim wisdom, so that prudence may obey you;

2 for she is upon the high summits, and has stood in the midst of the paths;

3 for she sits beside rulers' gates, and at entrances she is hymned:

4 You, O humans, I exhort, and send forth my voice to sons of humans;

5 understand shrewdness, innocent ones, and you undisciplined ones, put in a heart.

6 Hear me, for I shall speak noble things, and bring forth straight things from my lips;

7 because my throat will meditate truth, and lying lips are abhorred before me.

8 All the words of my mouth are with righteousness; nothing in them is crooked or twisted;

9 all are plain to those who understand, and straight to those who find knowledge.

10 Take discipline and not silver, and knowledge above tested gold, and choose perception instead of pure gold;

11 for wisdom is better than costly stones, and everything precious is not worthy of her.

12 I, wisdom, encamped in counsel, and I called upon knowledge and thought.

13 Fear of the Lord hates injustice, both insolence and arrogance and ways of evil ones; and I have hated perverted ways of evil ones.

14 Mine are counsel and security, mine prudence, and mine strength;

15 through me kings reign, and rulers write righteousness;

16 through me magnates are magnified, and tyrants through me hold power over earth.

17 I love those who love me, and those who seek me will find me.

18 Riches and glory belong to me, and possession of many things and righteousness;

19 it is better to reap fruit from me than gold and a precious stone, and my produce is better than choice silver.

20 I walk in ways of righteousness, and move about in the midst of paths of an ordinance,

21 so that I may apportion substance to those who love me, and fill their treasuries with good things.

21 a If I announce to you the things happening daily, I shall remember to number the things from an age.

22 The Lord created me as a beginning of his ways for his works;

23 before the age he founded me in the beginning,

24 before making the earth and before making the abysses, before the springs of waters came forth,

25 before mountains were established, and before all hills he begets me.

26 The Lord made regions and uninhabited places and inhabited extremities of the world under heaven.

27 When he was preparing heaven, I was present with him, and when he was setting apart his own throne upon winds.

28 When he was making the clouds above strong, and when he was setting secure springs of the world under heaven,

29 and was making the foundations of the earth strong,

30 I was beside him, fitting together; I was she in whom he delighted. And daily I was rejoicing before his face at every time,

31 when he was rejoicing, having completed the inhabited world, and was delighting in sons of humans.

32 Now therefore, son, hear me.

34 Blessed is a man who will hear me, and a human who will guard my ways, keeping awake at my doors daily, keeping the posts of my entrances;

35 for my exits are exits of life, and favor is prepared from the Lord.

36 But those who sin against me act ungodly toward their own souls, and those who hate me love death.

Chapter 9

1 Wisdom built a house for herself, and supported it with seven pillars;

2 she slaughtered her own sacrificial animals, mixed her own wine in a mixing bowl, and prepared her own table;

3 she sent out her own slaves, summoning with a loud proclamation to a mixing bowl, saying,

4 Whoever is foolish, let him turn aside to me; and to those lacking sense she said,

5 Come, eat of my bread, and drink wine which I mixed for you;

6 leave folly, and you will live, and seek prudence, so that you may live, and set understanding right with knowledge.

7 He who disciplines evil ones will receive dishonor for himself, and he who reproves the ungodly will blame himself.

8 Do not reprove evil ones, so that they may not hate you; reprove a wise one, and he will love you.

9 Give a wise one opportunity, and he will be wiser; make things known to a righteous one, and he will increase in receiving.

10 The beginning of wisdom is fear of the Lord, and counsel of holy ones is understanding;

10 a For knowing law belongs to good thought;

11 for in this manner you will live a long time, and years of your life will be added to you.

12 Son, if you become wise for yourself, you will be wise also for your neighbors; but if you turn out evil, you alone will draw up evils.

12 a He who leans upon lies will shepherd winds, and he himself will pursue flying birds;

13 for he forsook the ways of his own vineyard, and has strayed from the tracks of his own cultivated field;

14 and he passes through waterless wilderness and land laid out in thirsty places, and gathers fruitlessness with his hands.

13 A foolish and bold woman comes to lack a morsel, who does not know shame;

14 she sat at the doors of her own house upon a seat, conspicuously in squares,

15 calling to those passing by and going straight on their ways:

16 Whoever among you is most foolish, let him turn aside to me; and to those lacking prudence I exhort, saying,

17 Pleasantly partake of hidden bread and sweet water of theft.

18 But he does not know that earthborn ones perish beside her, and he meets with a ledge of Hades.

18 a But leap away; do not linger in the place, nor fix your eye toward her;

19 for thus you will cross foreign water and pass over a foreign river;

20 but abstain from foreign water, and do not drink from a foreign spring,

21 so that you may live a long time, and years of life be added to you. – –

Chapter 10

1 A wise son gladdens a father, but a foolish son is grief to his mother.

2 Treasures will not benefit lawless ones, but righteousness will deliver from death.

3 The Lord will not starve a righteous soul, but will overturn the life of the ungodly.

4 Poverty humbles a man, but hands of the valiant make rich.

4 a A disciplined son will be wise, and will use the foolish one as a servant.

5 An understanding son was preserved from burning heat, but a lawless son becomes wind-damaged at harvest.

6 The Lord's blessing is upon a righteous one's head, but untimely mourning will cover the mouth of the ungodly.

7 The memory of the righteous is with praises, but an ungodly one's name is extinguished.

8 One wise in heart will receive commandments, but one unrestrained in lips, speaking crookedly, will be tripped.

9 He who walks simply walks confidently, but he who perverts his ways will be known.

10 He who winks with eyes with deceit gathers griefs for men, but he who reproves with frankness makes peace.

11 A spring of life is in a righteous one's hand, but destruction will cover an ungodly one's mouth.

12 Hatred raises strife, but friendship covers all who are not contentious.

13 He who brings forth wisdom from lips strikes a man without heart with a rod.

14 The wise will hide perception, but a rash one's mouth draws near to shattering.

15 The possession of the rich is a fortified city, but poverty is the shattering of the ungodly.

16 Works of the righteous produce life, but fruits of the ungodly sins.

17 Discipline guards righteous ways of life, but discipline without reproof goes astray.

18 Righteous lips cover enmity, but those who bring forth abuse are most foolish.

19 From much speaking you will not escape sin, but sparing your lips, you will be understanding.

20 A righteous one's tongue is fire-tested silver, but an ungodly one's heart will fail.

21 Lips of the righteous know lofty things, but the foolish die in need.

22 The Lord's blessing is upon a righteous one's head; this makes rich, and grief in the heart will certainly not be added to it.

23 A foolish one does evils in laughter, but wisdom gives birth to prudence for a man.

24 An ungodly one is carried about in destruction, but a righteous one's desire is accepted.

25 When a storm passes by, an ungodly one vanishes, but a righteous one, turning aside, is saved unto the age.

26 As an unripe grape is harmful to teeth and smoke to eyes, so is lawlessness to those who use it.

27 Fear of the Lord adds days, but years of the ungodly will be diminished.

28 Gladness lingers for the righteous, but hope of the ungodly perishes.

29 Fear of the Lord is a holy one's stronghold, but shattering for those who work evils.

30 A righteous one will not give way unto the age, but the ungodly will not inhabit earth.

31 A righteous one's mouth drips wisdom, but an unjust one's tongue will be destroyed.

32 Lips of righteous men drip graces, but the mouth of the ungodly turns away.

Chapter 11

1 Deceitful scales are an abomination before the Lord, but a just weight is accepted by him.

2 Wherever insolence enters, there also is dishonor; but the mouth of the humble meditates wisdom.

3 A righteous one who died left regret, but destruction of the ungodly becomes ready and a cause of rejoicing.

5 Righteousness cuts blameless ways straight, but ungodliness falls into injustice.

6 Righteousness of upright men delivers them, but lawless ones are caught in their destruction.

7 When a righteous man dies, hope does not perish, but the boast of the ungodly perishes.

8 A righteous one escapes from a hunt, but the ungodly one is handed over in his place.

9 In the mouth of the ungodly is a snare for citizens, but perception of the righteous has a good way.

10 By good things of the righteous a city prospered,

11 but by mouths of the ungodly it was razed.

12 One lacking sense sneers at citizens, but a prudent man keeps quiet.

13 A double-tongued man reveals counsels in a council, but one faithful in breath hides matters.

14 Those who have no guidance fall like leaves, but salvation exists in much counsel.

15 An evil one does evil when he mingles with a righteous one, and hates the sound of security.

16 A gracious woman raises glory for a husband, but a woman who hates righteous things is a throne of dishonor. Sluggards come to lack riches, but the valiant are supported by riches.

17 A merciful man does good to his soul, but the merciless destroys his body.

18 An ungodly one does unjust works, but the seed of the righteous is a reward of truth.

19 A righteous son is born for life, but pursuit of an ungodly one is for death.

20 Perverted ways are an abomination to the Lord, but all blameless in their ways are acceptable to him.

21 He who puts hands into a hand unjustly will not be unpunished, but he who sows righteousness will receive a faithful reward.

22 As an earring in a pig's nose, so is beauty to an evil-minded woman.

23 Every desire of the righteous is good, but hope of the ungodly will perish.

24 There are those who sow their own things and make more, and there are also those who gather and are diminished.

25 Every blessed soul is simple, but an angry man is not seemly.

26 May he who holds grain back leave it to the nations, but blessing is upon the head of him who shares.

27 He who devises good things seeks good grace; but him who seeks out evils, they will overtake.

28 He who trusts in riches will fall, but he who takes hold of righteous ones will spring up.

29 He who does not go along with his own house will inherit wind, and a foolish one will serve a prudent one.

30 From the fruit of righteousness grows a tree of life, but souls of lawless ones are taken away untimely.

31 If the righteous one is scarcely saved, where will the ungodly and sinful one appear?

Chapter 12

1 He who loves discipline loves perception, but he who hates reproofs is foolish.

2 Better is he who found grace with the Lord, but a lawless man will be passed over in silence.

3 A human will not prosper from a lawless thing, but roots of the righteous will not be uprooted.

4 A valiant woman is a crown for her husband; but as a worm in wood, so an evildoing woman destroys a man.

5 Reasonings of the righteous are judgments, but the ungodly steer deceits.

6 Words of the ungodly are deceitful, but the mouth of the upright will deliver them.

7 Wherever he turns, an ungodly one vanishes, but houses of the righteous remain.

8 An understanding one's mouth is praised by a man, but the dull-hearted is sneered at.

9 Better is a man in dishonor serving himself than one putting honor around himself and needing bread.

10 A righteous one has compassion on souls of his beasts, but the bowels of the ungodly are merciless.

11 He who works his own land will be filled with bread, but those pursuing vain things lack sense.

11 a He who is pleased in pastimes of wine will leave dishonor in his own strongholds.

12 Desires of the ungodly are evil, but roots of the reverent are in strongholds.

13 Through sin of lips a sinner falls into snares, but a righteous one escapes from them.

13 a He who looks at smooth things will be shown mercy, but he who meets at gates will oppress souls.

14 From fruits of a mouth a man's soul will be filled with good things, and repayment of his lips will be given to him.

15 Ways of foolish ones are straight before them, but a wise one hears counsel.

16 A foolish one announces his wrath on the same day, but a shrewd one hides his own dishonor.

17 A righteous one announces displayed faithfulness, but the witness of unjust ones is deceitful.

18 There are those who, speaking, wound with a sword, but tongues of the wise heal.

19 True lips set testimony right, but a hasty witness has an unjust tongue.

20 Deceit is in the heart of one devising evils, but those wishing peace will rejoice.

21 Nothing unjust will please a righteous one, but the ungodly will be filled with evils.

22 Lying lips are an abomination to the Lord, but he who practices faithfulness is accepted by him.

23 An understanding man is a throne of perception, but the heart of foolish ones will meet curses.

24 The hand of chosen ones will rule easily, but deceitful ones will be for plunder.

25 A fearful word troubles a righteous man's heart, but a good announcement gladdens him.

26 A discerning righteous one will be his own friend, but judgments of the ungodly are ungentle. Evils will pursue those who sin, and the way of the ungodly will lead them astray.

27 A deceitful one will not attain prey, but a pure man is a precious possession.

28 In ways of righteousness is life, but ways of those bearing grudges lead to death.

Chapter 13

1 A shrewd son is obedient to a father, but a disobedient son is in destruction.

2 A good one will eat from fruits of righteousness, but souls of lawless ones will perish untimely.

3 He who guards his own mouth keeps his own soul, but one rash in lips will terrify himself.

4 Every idle one is in desires, but hands of the valiant are in diligence.

5 A righteous one hates an unjust word, but an ungodly one is ashamed and will have no frankness.

6 Righteousness guards the innocent, but sin makes the ungodly worthless.

7 There are those who make themselves rich, having nothing, and those who humble themselves amid much wealth.

8 A man's own wealth is the ransom of his soul, but a poor one does not endure a threat.

9 Light is for the righteous continually, but the light of the ungodly is extinguished.

9 a Deceitful souls wander in sins, but the righteous have compassion and show mercy.

10 An evil one does evils with insolence, but those discerning themselves are wise.

11 Substance hastily sought with lawlessness becomes less, but he who gathers for himself with reverence will be multiplied; a righteous one has compassion and lends.

12 Better is one who begins helping with heart than one who promises and leads into hope; for a good desire is a tree of life.

13 He who despises a matter will be despised by it, but he who fears a commandment is healthy.

13 a Nothing good will be for a deceitful son, but a wise household servant's deeds will prosper, and his way will be directed.

14 A wise one's law is a spring of life, but the senseless will die by a snare.

15 Good understanding gives grace, and knowing law belongs to good thought, but ways of despisers are in destruction.

16 Every shrewd one acts with knowledge, but a foolish one spread out his own evil.

17 A bold king will fall into evils, but a faithful messenger will deliver him.

18 Discipline takes away poverty and dishonor, but he who guards reproofs will be glorified.

19 Desires of the reverent sweeten a soul, but works of the ungodly are far from knowledge.

20 He who walks with wise ones will be wise, but he who walks with foolish ones will be known.

21 Evils will pursue sinners, but good things will overtake the righteous.

22 A good man will inherit sons of sons, but wealth of the ungodly is stored up for the righteous.

23 The righteous will spend many years in wealth, but the unjust will perish swiftly.

24 He who spares the staff hates his son, but he who loves disciplines diligently.

25 A righteous one, eating, fills his soul, but souls of the ungodly are needy.

Chapter 14

1 Wise women built houses, but the foolish woman razed them with her hands.

2 He who walks rightly fears the Lord, but he who is crooked in his ways will be dishonored.

3 From the mouth of foolish ones comes a staff of insolence, but lips of the wise guard them.

4 Where there are no oxen, mangers are clean; but where there is much produce, an ox's strength is evident.

5 A faithful witness does not lie, but an unjust witness kindles lies.

6 You will seek wisdom among evil ones and not find it, but perception is easy among the prudent.

7 All things are contrary to a foolish man, but wise lips are weapons of perception.

8 Wisdom of the shrewd will recognize their ways, but folly of foolish ones is in wandering.

9 Houses of lawless ones will owe cleansing, but houses of the righteous are accepted.

10 A man's heart is perceptive, his soul sorrowful; but when he rejoices, he does not mingle with insolence.

11 Houses of the ungodly will vanish, but tents of those acting rightly will stand.

12 There is a way which seems straight among humans, but its ends come to the bottom of Hades.

13 Grief does not mingle with gladnesses, but final joy comes to mourning.

14 The bold-hearted will be filled with his own ways, and a good man from his thoughts.

15 An innocent one believes every word, but a shrewd one comes to repentance.

16 A wise one, fearing, turned aside from evil, but a foolish one, trusting himself, mingles with a lawless one.

17 A quick-tempered one acts without counsel, but a prudent man bears many things.

18 Foolish ones will apportion evil, but the shrewd will take hold of perception.

19 Evil ones will slip before good ones, and the ungodly will attend at doors of the righteous.

20 Friends will hate poor friends, but friends of the rich are many.

21 He who dishonors needy ones sins, but he who shows mercy to the poor is blessed.

22 Those wandering devise evils, but good ones devise mercy and truth. Makers of evils do not know mercy and faithfulness, but mercies and faithfulnesses are with good makers.

23 In everyone taking care there is abundance, but the pleasure-loving and insensible will be in need.

24 A shrewd one is a crown of the wise, but the pastime of foolish ones is evil.

25 A faithful witness will deliver a soul from evils, but a deceitful one kindles lies.

26 In fear of the Lord is hope of strength, and for his children he leaves support.

27 A command of the Lord is a spring of life, and makes one turn aside from a snare of death.

28 In a numerous nation is a king's glory, but in a people's failing is a ruler's shattering.

29 A long-suffering man is abundant in prudence, but the faint-hearted is exceedingly foolish.

30 A mild-tempered man is a physician of hearts, but a perceptive heart is a moth of bones.

31 He who oppresses a needy one provokes him who made him, but he who honors him shows mercy to a poor one.

32 In his evil an ungodly one will be thrust away, but he who trusts in his own holiness is righteous.

33 Wisdom is in a man's good heart, but in a heart of foolish ones it is not discerned.

34 Righteousness exalts a nation, but sins diminish tribes.

35 An understanding attendant is accepted by a king, and through his own adaptability takes away dishonor.

Chapter 15

1 Wrath destroys even prudent ones, but a submissive answer turns away anger, and a grievous word raises wraths.

2 A tongue of wise ones knows good things, but a mouth of foolish ones will announce evils.

3 The Lord's eyes are in every place; they observe both evil and good ones.

4 Healing of a tongue is a tree of life, and he who preserves it will be filled with spirit.

5 A foolish one sneers at a father's discipline, but he who guards commandments is shrewder.

6 In abundant righteousness is much strength, but the ungodly will perish from earth, roots and all. In houses of the righteous is much strength, but fruits of the ungodly will perish.

7 Lips of the wise are bound to perception, but hearts of foolish ones are not secure.

8 Sacrifices of the ungodly are an abomination to the Lord, but prayers of those directing rightly are accepted by him.

9 Ways of an ungodly one are an abomination to the Lord, but he loves those pursuing righteousness.

10 An innocent one's discipline is recognized by those passing by, but those who hate reproofs die shamefully.

11 Hades and destruction are evident with the Lord; how not also hearts of humans?

12 An undisciplined one will not love those who reprove him, and will not converse with wise ones.

13 When a heart rejoices, a face flourishes, but when it is in griefs, it grows gloomy.

14 An upright heart seeks perception, but a mouth of the undisciplined will know evils.

15 All the time the eyes of evil ones await evils, but good ones rest continually.

16 Better is a small portion with fear of the Lord than great treasures with fearlessness.

17 Better is hospitality of vegetables with friendship and grace than a serving of calves with enmity.

18 An angry man prepares battles, but a long-suffering one calms even a coming one.

18 a A long-suffering man will extinguish disputes, but the ungodly one raises them more.

19 Ways of the idle are strewn with thorns, but those of the valiant are worn smooth.

20 A wise son gladdens a father, but a foolish son sneers at his mother.

21 Paths of a senseless one lack sense, but a prudent man walks directing rightly.

22 Those who do not honor councils postpone reasonings, but counsel remains in hearts of those deliberating.

23 The evil one will certainly not obey it, nor say anything timely and good for the community.

24 An understanding one's thoughts are ways of life, so that, turning aside from Hades, he may be saved.

25 The Lord tears down houses of insolent ones, but he established a widow's boundary.

26 An unjust reasoning is an abomination to the Lord, but utterances of the pure are noble.

27 The bribe-taker destroys himself, but he who hates taking gifts is saved.

27 a By mercies and faithfulnesses sins are cleansed away, and by fear of the Lord everyone turns aside from evil.

28 Hearts of the righteous meditate faithfulnesses, but a mouth of the ungodly answers evils.

28 a Ways of righteous humans are accepted by the Lord, and through them even enemies become friends.

29 God is far distant from the ungodly, but he hears prayers of the righteous.

29 a Better is a little receipt with righteousness than much produce with injustice.

30 Let a man's heart reason righteous things, so that his steps may be set right by God. An eye observing good things gladdens a heart, and a good report fattens bones.

32 He who thrusts discipline away hates himself, but he who keeps reproofs loves his soul.

33 Fear of God is discipline and wisdom, and a beginning of glory will answer her.

Chapter 16

2 2 All the works of the humble are manifest before God, but the ungodly will perish on an evil day.

5 Every high-hearted person is unclean before God, and one who has unjustly put hands into a hand will not be acquitted.

7 The beginning of a good way is to do righteous things, and they are more acceptable before God than sacrificing sacrifices.

8 The one seeking the Lord will find knowledge with righteousness, and those rightly seeking him will find peace.

9 All the works of the Lord are with righteousness, but the ungodly is kept for an evil day.

10 An oracle is on a king's lips, and in judgment his mouth will certainly not go astray.

11 The balance's inclination is righteousness with the Lord, and his works are righteous weights.

12 The one doing evil things is an abomination to a king, for a throne of rule is prepared with righteousness.

13 Righteous lips are acceptable to a king, and he loves upright words.

14 A king's wrath is a messenger of death, but a wise man will appease him.

15 In the light of life is a king's son, and those acceptable to him are like a late cloud.

16 Nests of wisdom are more desirable than gold, and nests of prudence are more desirable than silver.

17 Paths of life turn away from evil things, and ways of righteousness are length of life. The one receiving discipline will be amid good things, and the one keeping reproofs will be made wise. Whoever keeps his own ways preserves his own soul; and loving his life, he will spare his mouth.

18 Arrogance leads before shattering, and evil-mindedness before a fall.

19 Better is a gentle-tempered person with humility than one who divides spoils with arrogant people.

20 One understanding in matters is a finder of good things, and one trusting in God is blessed.

21 They call the wise and understanding worthless, but those sweet in speech will hear more.

22 Thought is a spring of life to those possessing it, but the discipline of senseless people is evil.

23 A wise person's heart will understand the things from his own mouth, and on his lips he will carry discernment.

24 Good words are honeycombs, and their sweetness is healing of a soul.

25 There are ways seeming to be upright to a man, yet their last things look toward the bottom of Hades.

26 A man in labors labors for himself and forces his own destruction, yet the crooked person carries destruction on his own mouth.

27 A senseless man digs evil things for himself, and on his own lips he stores up fire.

28 A crooked man sends evil things abroad and lights a torch of deceit for evil people and separates friends.

29 A lawless man tries friends and leads them away along ways that are not good.

30 Fixing his eyes, he reckons perverted things, and with his lips he determines all evil things; this person is a furnace of wickedness.

31 Old age is a crown of boasting, and it is found in ways of righteousness.

32 A long-tempered man is better than a strong one, and the one controlling anger is better than one taking a city.

33 Everything comes into the bosoms of the unjust, but all righteous things are from the Lord.

Chapter 17

1 Better is a morsel with pleasure in peace than a house full of many good things and unjust sacrifices with fighting.

2 An intelligent servant will rule senseless masters, and among brothers he will divide shares.

3 Just as silver and gold are tested in a furnace, so hearts are chosen before the Lord.

4 An evil person listens to the tongue of lawless people, but a righteous person does not attend to lying lips.

5 The one laughing at a poor person provokes the one who made him, and the one rejoicing over someone being destroyed will not be acquitted; but the one having compassion will receive mercy.

6 Children's children are a crown of old people, and their fathers are the boast of children.

6 a The whole world of possessions belongs to the faithful person, but not even an obol to the unfaithful.

7 Faithful lips will not suit a senseless person, nor lying lips a righteous person.

8 Discipline is a reward of graces to those using it, and wherever it turns, it will prosper.

9 Whoever hides wrongdoings seeks friendship; but whoever hates hiding them separates friends and kin.

10 A threat shatters a prudent person's heart, but a senseless person, having been whipped, does not perceive.

11 Every evil person raises disputes, but the Lord will send out a merciless messenger to him.

12 Anxiety will fall upon an intelligent man, but the senseless will reason about evil things.

13 Whoever repays evil things for good things, evil things will not be moved from his house.

14 The beginning of righteousness gives authority to words, but dissension and fighting precede want.

15 Whoever judges the unjust person righteous, but the righteous person unjust, is unclean and abominable before God.

16 Why did possessions belong to a senseless person? For one without a heart will not be able to acquire wisdom.

16 a Whoever makes his own house high seeks shattering; but the one turning crookedly away from learning will fall into evil things.

17 Let a friend belong to you at every time, and let brothers be useful in necessities; for this reason they are born.

18 A senseless man claps and rejoices over himself, as also the one guaranteeing his own friend with a guarantee.

19 A lover of sin rejoices in fights,

20 but the hard-hearted person does not encounter good things. A man changeable in tongue will fall into evil things,

21 and a senseless person's heart is pain to the one possessing it. A father is not gladdened over an undisciplined son, but a prudent son gladdens his mother.

22 A gladdened heart makes one be in good condition, but a sorrowful man's bones are dried up.

23 The ways of one unjustly receiving gifts in his bosom do not prosper, and an ungodly person turns aside ways of righteousness.

24 An understanding face belongs to a wise man, but the senseless person's eyes are at the ends of the earth.

25 A senseless son is anger to a father and pain to her who bore him.

26 To punish a righteous man is not good, nor is it holy to plot against righteous rulers.

27 Whoever refrains from uttering a harsh word is discerning; and a long-tempered man is prudent.

28 To an unintelligent person who has asked about wisdom, it will be reckoned as wisdom, and someone who has made himself mute will seem to be prudent.

Chapter 18

1 A man wishing to separate himself from friends seeks pretexts, and at every time he will be reproached.

2 One lacking sense has no need of wisdom; for he is rather led by senselessness.

3 When an ungodly person comes into a depth of evil things, he despises, and dishonor and reproach come upon him.

4 A word in a man's heart is deep water, and a river and a spring of life well up.

5 To admire an ungodly person's face is not good, nor is it holy to turn aside what is just in judgment.

6 A senseless person's lips lead him into evil things, and his rash mouth calls upon death.

7 A senseless person's mouth is shattering to him, and his lips are a trap to his soul.

8 Fear casts down the slothful, and the souls of effeminate men will hunger.

9 The one not healing himself in his works is brother to the one ruining himself.

10 The Lord's name is from greatness of strength, and righteous people, having run to it, are exalted.

11 A rich man's possessions are a fortified city, and its glory greatly overshadows.

12 Before shattering a man's heart is exalted, and before glory it is humbled.

13 Whoever answers a word before hearing, it is senselessness and reproach to him.

14 A prudent attendant soothes a man's temper; but who will bear a faint-hearted man?

15 A prudent person's heart acquires perception, and wise people's ears seek thought.

16 A person's gift makes room for him and seats him beside rulers.

17 A righteous person is his own accuser in his first speech; but when the opponent comes against him, he is reproved.

18 A lot stops disputes, and among rulers it determines.

19 A brother helped by a brother is like a fortified and high city, and he is strong like a founded palace.

20 From fruits of a mouth a man fills his belly, and from fruits of his lips he will be filled.

21 Death and life are in the hand of a tongue, and those controlling it will eat its fruits.

22 Whoever found a good wife found graces, and received cheerfulness from God.

22 a Whoever casts out a good wife casts out good things; but the one retaining an adulteress is senseless and ungodly.

Chapter 19

3 3 A man's senselessness ruins his ways, but he blames God in his heart.

4 Wealth adds many friends, but the poor person is left even by his existing friend.

5 A false witness will not be unpunished, and the one accusing unjustly will not escape.

6 Many attend upon kings' faces, but every evil person becomes a reproach to a man.

7 Everyone who hates a poor brother will also be far from friendship. Good thought will draw near to those knowing it, and a prudent man will find it. The one doing many evil things brings wickedness to completion; but whoever provokes words will not be saved.

8 The one acquiring prudence loves himself; but whoever keeps prudence will find good things.

9 A false witness will not be unpunished; but whoever kindles wickedness will be destroyed by it.

10 Luxury does not benefit a senseless person, nor if a servant begins to exercise power with arrogance.

11 A merciful man is long-tempered, and his boast comes upon lawless people.

12 A king's threat is like a lion's growling; but as dew on grass, so is his cheerfulness.

13 A senseless son is shame to a father, and vows from a courtesan's hire are not pure.

14 Fathers apportion a house and possessions to children, but a wife is joined to a man by God.

15 Cowardice holds an effeminate man, and an idle person's soul will hunger.

16 Whoever keeps a commandment preserves his own soul; but the one despising his own ways will perish.

17 The one showing mercy to a poor person lends to God, and according to his gift he will repay him.

18 Discipline your son, for thus he will be hopeful; but do not be lifted up toward arrogance in your soul.

19 An evil-minded man will suffer many penalties; but if he acts pestilently, he will also add his soul.

20 Hear, son, your father's discipline, so that you may become wise at your last things.

21 Many reasonings are in a man's heart, but the Lord's counsel remains forever.

22 Mercifulness is fruit for a man, and a righteous poor person is better than a rich liar.

23 Fear of the Lord is for life to a man, but the fearless person will lodge in places where knowledge is not visited.

24 The one unjustly hiding hands in his bosom will certainly not even bring them to his mouth.

25 When a pestilent person is whipped, a senseless person becomes shrewder; but if you reprove a prudent man, he will understand perception.

26 The one dishonoring a father and thrusting away his mother will be put to shame and will be reproached.

27 A son neglecting to keep a father's discipline will practice evil utterances.

28 The one guaranteeing a senseless child insults a righteous requirement, and the mouth of ungodly people swallows judgments.

29 Whips are prepared for the undisciplined, and punishments for the shoulders of senseless people.

Chapter 20

1 Wine is undisciplined and drunkenness arrogant, and everyone mingling with it will not be wise.

2 A king's threat does not differ from a lion's wrath, and the one provoking him sins against his own soul.

3 It is glory for a man to turn away from insults, but every senseless person becomes entangled in such things.

4 A slothful person being reproached is not ashamed, likewise also the one borrowing grain at harvest.

5 Counsel in a man's heart is deep water, but a prudent man will draw it out.

6 A person is a great thing, and a merciful man a precious thing, but to find a faithful man is a task.

7 Whoever conducts himself blameless in righteousness will leave his children blessed.

8 When a righteous king sits on a throne, every evil thing does not oppose him before his eyes.

9 Who will boast of having a pure heart? Or who will speak frankly of being clean from sins?

9 a The lamp of one speaking evil of a father or mother will be extinguished, and the pupils of his eyes will see darkness.

10 A portion eagerly pursued at the first will not be blessed at the last.

11 Do not say, I will punish the enemy; but wait for the Lord, so that he may help you.

10 A great and a small weight and double measures, both are unclean before the Lord.

11 And the one doing them will be fettered in his practices, a young man with a holy person, and his way is straight.

12 An ear hears and an eye sees; both are works of the Lord.

13 Do not love speaking against others, so that you may not be removed; open your eyes and be filled with breads.

23 A double weight is an abomination to the Lord, and a deceitful balance is not good before him.

24 A man's steps are directed by the Lord; but how could a mortal understand his ways?

25 It is a trap for a man hastily to consecrate something of his own; for after making a vow, repenting happens.

26 A wise king is a winnower of ungodly people, and he will bring a wheel upon them.

27 The breath of humans is a light of the Lord, who searches chambers of a belly.

28 Mercifulness and truth are a guard for a king, and they will surround his throne in righteousness.

29 Wisdom is an ornament to young men, and gray hairs the glory of elders.

30 Bruises and fractures encounter evil people, and blows reach chambers of a belly.

Chapter 21

1 As a rush of water, so a king's heart is in God's hand; wherever, willing, he nods, there he inclined it.

2 Every man appears righteous to himself, but the Lord directs hearts.

3 To do righteous things and speak truth are more pleasing before God than blood of sacrifices.

4 A lofty-minded person is bold-hearted toward arrogance, and the lamp of ungodly people is sin.

6 The one producing treasures with a lying tongue pursues vain things toward traps of death.

7 Destruction will lodge with ungodly people; for they do not wish to practice righteous things.

8 God sends crooked ways toward the crooked; for his works are pure and upright.

9 It is better to dwell on a corner in the open air than in plastered places with injustice and in a shared house.

10 An ungodly person's soul will receive mercy from none of the humans.

11 When an undisciplined person is punished, the innocent person becomes shrewder, and a wise person, understanding, will receive knowledge.

12 A righteous person understands the hearts of ungodly people and despises ungodly people amid evil things.

13 Whoever blocks his ears so as not to hear a weak person, he himself too will call, and there will be no one listening.

14 A secret gift overturns angers, but the one sparing gifts raises strong wrath.

15 It is the gladness of righteous people to execute judgment, but a holy person is unclean before evildoers.

16 A man wandering from a way of righteousness will rest in an assembly of giants.

17 A needy man loves gladness, loving wine and oil for wealth;

18 and a lawless person is a cleansing-offering for a righteous person.

19 It is better to dwell in a desert land than with a quarrelsome and talkative and irascible woman.

20 A desirable treasure will rest on a wise person's mouth, but senseless men swallow it.

21 A way of righteousness and mercifulness will find life and glory.

22 A wise person climbed fortified cities and pulled down the stronghold in which ungodly people had trusted.

23 Whoever guards his mouth and tongue preserves his soul from affliction.

24 A rash and self-willed and boastful person is called pestilent; but whoever bears a grudge is lawless.

25 Desires kill a slothful person; for his hands do not choose to do anything.

26 An ungodly person desires evil desires the whole day, but the righteous person shows mercy and compassion unsparingly.

27 Sacrifices of ungodly people are an abomination to the Lord; for they also offer them lawlessly.

28 A false witness will perish, but an obedient man, being guarded, will speak.

29 An ungodly man stands shamelessly with his face, but the upright person himself understands his ways.

30 There is no wisdom, there is no courage, there is no counsel against the ungodly person.

31 A horse is prepared for a day of war, but help is from the Lord.

Chapter 22

1 A good name is more desirable than much wealth, and good grace above silver and gold.

2 A rich person and a poor person met one another, and the Lord made both.

3 A shrewd person, seeing an evil person being severely punished, is himself disciplined, but the senseless passed by and were punished.

4 The offspring of wisdom are fear of the Lord and wealth and glory and life.

5 Thistles and traps are in crooked ways, but the one guarding his own soul will abstain from them.

7 Rich people will rule poor people, and servants will lend to their own masters.

8 The one sowing worthless things will reap evil things, and he will bring to completion the blow of his works.

8 a God blesses a cheerful man and giver, and he will bring to completion the vanity of his works.

9 The one showing mercy to a poor person will himself be nourished; for he gave of his own breads to the poor person.

9 a The one giving gifts obtains victory and honor, yet he takes away the soul of those possessing them.

10 Cast a pestilent person out of a council, and strife will go out together with him; for whenever he sits in a council, he dishonors everyone.

11 The Lord loves holy hearts, and all blameless people are acceptable to him; a king shepherds with lips.

12 And the Lord's eyes preserve perception, but a lawless person despises words.

13 A slothful person makes excuses and says, A lion is in the ways, and murderers in the broad streets.

14 A lawless person's mouth is a deep pit, and the one hated by the Lord will fall into it.

14 a Evil ways are before a man, and he does not love turning away from them; but one must turn away from a crooked and evil way.

15 Unintelligence is attached to a young person's heart, but a rod and discipline are far from him.

16 The one extorting from a needy person makes his own things many; but he gives to a rich person for less. – –

17 Bring your ear alongside wise people's words and hear my word, and apply your heart, so that you may know that they are good;

18 and if you put them into your heart, they will gladden you together on your lips,

19 so that your hope may be upon the Lord and he may make his way known to you.

20 And you too copy them for yourself threefold for counsel and knowledge upon the breadth of your heart.

21 I therefore teach you a true word and good knowledge to heed, to answer words of truth to those putting questions to you.

22 Do not oppress a needy person, for he is poor, and do not dishonor a weak person in gates;

23 for the Lord will judge his case, and you will deliver your soul safe from seizure.

24 Do not be a companion to a wrathful man, and do not lodge together with an irascible friend,

25 lest you learn his ways and take snares for your soul.

26 Do not give yourself as a guarantee out of shame before a face;

27 for if you have nothing from which to repay, they will take the bedding beneath your sides.

28 Do not move everlasting boundaries which your fathers set.

29 A perceptive man and keen in his works must stand before kings and not stand before sluggish men.

Chapter 23

1 If you sit to dine at a table of rulers, understand intelligently the things set before you

2 and put forth your hand, knowing that you must prepare such things;

3 but if you are more insatiable, do not desire his dishes, for these belong to a false life.

4 Do not stretch yourself alongside a rich person, being needy, but abstain in your thought;

5 if you fix your eye toward him, he will appear nowhere, for wings like an eagle's have been prepared for him, and he returns to the house of the one presiding over him.

6 Do not dine together with an envious man, nor desire his foods;

7 for in the way that someone might swallow a hair, so he eats and drinks.

8 Nor bring him in to you and eat your morsel with him; for he will vomit it out and ruin your good words.

9 Say nothing into a senseless person's ears, lest he sneer at your understanding words.

10 Do not shift everlasting boundaries, and do not enter into orphans' property;

11 for the Lord redeeming them is mighty and will judge their case with you.

12 Give your heart to discipline, and prepare your ears for words of perception.

13 Do not refrain from disciplining an infant, because if you strike him with a rod, he will certainly not die;

14 for you will strike him with a rod, but you will deliver his soul from death.

15 Son, if your heart becomes wise, you will gladden my heart also,

16 and your lips will spend time in words with my lips, if they are upright.

17 Let your heart not envy sinners, but be in fear of the Lord the whole day;

18 for if you keep them, you will have offspring, and your hope will not depart.

19 Hear, son, and become wise and direct the thoughts of your heart;

20 do not be a wine-drinker, nor stretch yourself to contributions and purchases of meats;

21 for every drunkard and frequenter of prostitutes will become poor, and every sleepy person will clothe himself in torn and ragged things.

22 Hear, son, the father who begot you, and do not despise your mother because she has grown old.

24 A righteous father nourishes well, and his soul is gladdened over a wise son;

25 let the father and mother be gladdened over you, and let her who bore you rejoice.

26 Give me, son, your heart, and let your eyes keep my ways;

27 for a stranger's house is a pierced jar, and a stranger's well is narrow;

28 for this one will quickly perish, and every lawless person will be consumed.

29 For whom is woe? For whom tumult? For whom judgment? For whom unpleasantness and chatter? For whom fractures for nothing? Whose eyes are livid?

30 Are they not those lingering among wines? Are they not those tracking where drinking parties take place?

31 Do not become drunk with wine, but associate with righteous humans and associate on walks; for if you give your eyes to the bowls and cups, afterward you will walk about more naked than a pestle,

32 and at the last he stretches out as though struck by a snake, and as though by a horned snake the venom is poured through him.

33 When your eyes see a strange woman, your mouth will then speak crooked things,

34 and you will lie down as in the heart of the sea and as a helmsman in much surging;

35 and you will say, They strike me, and I did not suffer, and they mocked me, but I did not know; when will dawn be, so that I may come and seek those with whom I will meet?

Chapter 24

1 Son, do not envy evil men, nor desire to be with them;

2 for their heart practices lies, and their lips speak troubles.

3 With wisdom a house is built, and with understanding it is set upright;

4 with perception chambers are filled with all precious and good wealth.

5 A wise person is better than a strong one, and a man having prudence than a great farm;

6 with guidance war takes place, and help with a deliberative heart.

7 Wisdom and good thought are in wise people's gates; wise people do not turn aside from the Lord's mouth,

8 but deliberate in councils. Death encounters the undisciplined,

9 and a senseless person dies in sins; and uncleanness will be polluted for a pestilent man

10 on an evil day and on a day of affliction, until it fails.

11 Deliver those being led to death and ransom those being killed; do not spare;

12 but if you say, I do not know this person, know that the Lord knows everyone's hearts, and the one fashioning breath for all himself knows everything, who repays each according to his works.

13 Eat honey, son, for a honeycomb is good, so that your throat may be sweetened;

14 thus you will perceive wisdom for your soul; for if you find it, your end will be good, and hope will not abandon you.

15 Do not bring an ungodly person to righteous people's pasture, nor be deceived by a belly's fullness;

16 for the righteous person will fall seven times and rise, but ungodly people will become weak amid evil things.

17 If your enemy falls, do not rejoice over him, and at his stumbling do not be lifted up;

18 because the Lord will see, and it will not please him, and he will turn his wrath away from him.

19 Do not rejoice over evildoers, nor envy sinners;

20 for there will certainly not be offspring of evil people, and the lamp of ungodly people will be extinguished.

21 Fear God, son, and a king, and disobey neither of them;

22 for suddenly they will punish the ungodly, and who will know the punishments of both?

22 a A son keeping a word will be outside destruction, and receiving, he received it.

23 Let no lie from a tongue be spoken to a king, and no lie will certainly come out from his tongue.

24 A king's tongue is a sword and not fleshy, and whoever is handed over will be shattered;

25 for if his wrath is sharpened, it consumes humans together with sinews

26 and devours humans' bones and burns them together like a flame, so that they are uneatable for young eagles. – –

Chapter 30

1 Fear my words, son, and having received them, repent; these things the man says to those trusting God, and I cease;

2 for I am the most senseless of all humans, and humans' prudence is not in me;

3 God has taught me wisdom, and I have known knowledge of holy things.

4 Who went up into heaven and came down? Who gathered winds in a bosom? Who wrapped water in a garment? Who held all the ends of the earth? What is his name, or what is the name of his children, so that you may know?

5 All God's words have been tried by fire, and he himself shields those revering him;

6 do not add to his words, so that he may not reprove you and you become false.

7 I ask two things from you; do not take grace away from me before I die;

8 make a vain and false word far from me, and do not give me wealth and poverty, but appoint for me necessary and sufficient things,

9 so that, filled, I may not become false and say, Who sees me? Or, made needy, steal and swear the name of God.

10 Do not hand a servant into a master's hands, lest he curse you and you disappear.

11 An evil offspring curses a father, but does not bless the mother;

12 an evil offspring judges itself righteous, but did not wash away its discharge;

13 an evil offspring has lofty eyes, and is lifted up in its eyelids;

14 an evil offspring has swords as teeth and knives as molars, so as to consume and devour the humble from the earth and their needy from among humans. – –

23 And these things I say to you wise people to recognize: to respect a face in judgment is not good;

24 the one saying of the ungodly person, He is righteous, will be accursed among peoples and hated among nations;

25 but those reproving will appear better, and a good blessing will come upon them;

26 and lips answering good words will kiss.

27 Prepare your works for going out and make ready for the field and go behind me, and you will rebuild your house.

28 Do not be a false witness against your fellow citizen, nor widen with your lips;

29 do not say, In the way he treated me I will treat him, and I will punish him for the things in which he wronged me.

30 A senseless man is like a farm, and a human lacking sense like a vineyard;

31 if you leave him, he will become waste and wholly overgrown with grass and becomes abandoned, and his stone fences are demolished.

32 Afterward I repented; I looked to choose discipline.

33 I doze a little, and sleep a little, and embrace my breast with hands a little;

34 but if you do this, your poverty will come walking ahead, and your want like a good runner. – –

15 The leech had three daughters loved with love, and these three did not fill her, and the fourth was not content to say, Sufficient;

16 Hades and a woman's love and Tartarus and earth not filled with water and water and fire will certainly not say, It suffices.

17 An eye laughing at a father and dishonoring a mother's old age, may ravens from the ravines cut it out, and may young eagles devour it.

18 And there are three things impossible for me to understand, and the fourth I do not recognize;

19 tracks of an eagle flying and ways of a snake on a rock and paths of a ship crossing the sea and ways of a man in youth.

20 Such is the way of an adulterous woman who, whenever she acts, having washed herself, says she has done nothing improper.

21 Through three things the earth is shaken, and the fourth it cannot bear;

22 if a servant becomes king, and a senseless person is filled with foods,

23 and if a maidservant casts out her own mistress, and if a hated woman obtains a good man.

24 And there are four smallest things on the earth, and these are wiser than the wise;

25 the ants, which have no strength and prepare food in summer;

26 and the rock-rabbits, a nation not strong, which made their own houses in rocks;

27 the locust is without a king and marches out orderly from one command;

28 and a lizard, supporting itself with hands and being easily caught, dwells in a king's strongholds.

29 And there are three things that proceed well, and the fourth that walks well;

30 a lion's cub stronger than beasts, which does not turn away nor cower before a beast,

31 and a cock walking among females, spirited, and a he-goat leading a goat herd, and a king addressing an assembly among a nation.

32 If you give yourself up to gladness and stretch out your hand with fighting, you will be dishonored.

33 Milk milk, and there will be butter; but if you squeeze nostrils, blood will come out; and if you draw out words, judgments and fights will come out. – –

Chapter 31

1 My words have been spoken by God, an oracle of a king whom his mother disciplined.

2 What, child, will you keep? What? Utterances of God; firstborn, I speak to you, son; what, child of my belly? What, child of my vows?

3 Do not give your wealth to women, and your mind and life to later regret.

4 Do everything with counsel, drink wine with counsel; rulers are wrathful, and let them not drink wine,

5 so that, having drunk, they may not forget wisdom and certainly be unable to judge weak people rightly.

6 Give drunkenness to those in griefs and wine to drink to those in pains,

7 so that they may forget poverty and remember troubles no longer.

8 Open your mouth with God's word and judge everyone soundly;

9 open your mouth and judge righteously, and distinguish a needy and weak person. – –

Chapter 25

1 These are the unseparated disciplines of Salomon, which the friends of Ezekias the king of Ioudaia copied out.

2 God's glory hides a word, but a king's glory honors matters.

3 Heaven is high and earth deep, and a king's heart unsearchable.

4 Beat unapproved silver, and it will all be purified clean;

5 kill ungodly people from a king's presence, and his throne will be set right in righteousness.

6 Do not boast before a king, nor stand in rulers' places;

7 for it is better for you to be told, Come up to me, than for him to humble you in a ruler's presence. Say what your eyes saw.

8 Do not rush into a fight quickly, so that you may not regret it at the last. Whenever your friend reproaches you,

9 withdraw backward; do not despise,

10 lest the friend reproach you, and your fight and enmity will not depart, but will be equal to death for you.

10 a Grace and friendship set free; keep them for yourself, so that you may not become reproached, but guard your ways conciliatorily.

11 A golden apple in a little necklace of sardius, so is speaking a word.

12 A costly sardius has been bound into a golden earring, a wise word into a readily hearing ear.

13 Just as an outflow of snow at harvest in heat benefits, so a faithful messenger benefits those sending him; for he benefits the souls of those using him.

14 Like winds and clouds and most conspicuous rains, so are those boasting over a false gift.

15 In long-temperedness is prosperity for kings, and a soft tongue shatters bones.

16 Having found honey, eat what is sufficient, lest, filled, you vomit it out.

17 Bring your foot to your own friend rarely, lest, filled with you, he hate you.

18 A club and a sword and a pointed arrow, so also is the man testifying a false testimony against his friend.

19 An evil person's tooth and a lawless person's foot will perish on an evil day.

20 Just as vinegar is disadvantageous to a wound, so a suffering befalling a body grieves a heart.

20 a Just as a moth harms a garment and a worm wood, so a man's grief harms a heart.

21 If your enemy hungers, feed him; if he thirsts, give him drink;

22 for doing this you will heap coals of fire on his head, and the Lord will repay you good things.

23 A north wind raises clouds, and a shameless face provokes a tongue.

24 It is better to dwell on a corner of a roof than with an abusive woman in a shared house.

25 Just as cold water is pleasant to a thirsty soul, so is good news from a land far away.

26 As if someone were to block a spring and ruin an outflow of water, so it is unseemly for a righteous person to have fallen before an ungodly person.

27 To eat much honey is not good, but one must honor glorious words.

28 Like a city with its walls cast down and unwalled, so is a man who does anything without counsel.

Chapter 26

1 Like dew at harvest and like rain in summer, so honor is not for a senseless person.

2 Just as birds and sparrows fly, so a vain curse will come upon no one.

3 Like a whip for a horse and a goad for a donkey, so is a rod for a lawless nation.

4 Do not answer a senseless person in relation to his senselessness, so that you may not become like him;

5 but answer a senseless person according to his senselessness, so that he may not appear wise to himself.

6 The one sending a word through a senseless messenger will drink reproach from his own feet.

7 Take away the walking of legs and a proverb from the mouth of senseless people.

8 Whoever binds a stone in a sling is like the one giving glory to a senseless person.

9 Thorns grow in a drunkard's hand, and slavery in the hand of senseless people.

10 All flesh of senseless people is greatly storm-tossed; for their bewilderment is shattered.

11 Just as a dog, whenever it comes upon its own vomit and becomes hated, so is a senseless person who by his own wickedness has returned to his own sin.

11 a There is shame bringing sin, and there is shame that is glory and grace.

12 I saw a man who thought himself wise, yet a senseless person had more hope than he.

13 A slothful person being sent on a way says, A lion is in the ways.

14 Just as a door turns on its hinge, so a slothful person on his bed.

15 A slothful person, having hidden his hand in his bosom, will not be able to bring it to his mouth.

16 A slothful person appears to himself wiser than the one bringing back a message in fullness.

17 Like the one holding a dog's tail, so is the one presiding over a stranger's case.

18 Just as those healing put words before humans, and the first one encountering the word will be tripped,

19 so are all those ambushing their own friends, but whenever they are detected, they say, I did it playing.

20 Among many pieces of wood a fire flourishes, but where there is no double-minded person, a fight is quiet.

21 A hearth for coals and wood for fire, and an abusive man for the disturbance of a fight.

22 Words of rogues are soft, but these strike into chambers of the inward parts.

23 Silver given with deceit must be considered like a potsherd. Smooth lips cover a sorrowful heart.

24 An enemy lamenting assents to everything with lips, but in his heart he devises deceits;

25 if the enemy begs you with a loud voice, do not be persuaded; for seven evils are in his soul.

26 The one hiding enmity establishes deceit, but one readily known in councils reveals his own sins.

27 The one digging a pit for his neighbor will fall into it, and the one rolling a stone rolls it upon himself.

28 A lying tongue hates truth, and an unrestrained mouth makes disorders.

Chapter 27

1 Do not boast of the things for tomorrow; for you do not know what the coming day will bear.

2 Let the neighbor praise you and not your mouth, a stranger and not your lips.

3 A stone is heavy and sand hard to bear, but a senseless person's anger is heavier than both.

4 Wrath is merciless and anger sharp, but jealousy withstands no one.

5 Revealed reproofs are better than hidden friendship.

6 A friend's wounds are more trustworthy than an enemy's willing kisses.

7 A soul being in fullness mocks honeycombs, but to a needy soul even bitter things appear sweet.

8 Just as when a bird flies down out of its own nest, so a human is enslaved whenever he is estranged from his own places.

9 A heart is delighted by ointments and wines and incenses, but a soul is torn apart by misfortunes.

10 Do not abandon your friend or an ancestral friend, and do not enter your brother's house when unfortunate; a friend nearby is better than a brother dwelling far away.

11 Become wise, son, so that my heart may be gladdened, and turn reproachful words away from yourself.

12 A shrewd person hid himself when evil things were coming, but senseless people, having come upon them, will pay a penalty.

13 Take away his garment, for he passed by; whoever ruins others' things is arrogant.

14 Whoever blesses a friend early with a loud voice will seem to differ in nothing from one cursing.

15 Drops cast a human out of his house on a winter day, likewise also an abusive woman out of his own house.

16 The north wind is a harsh wind, but by name it is called favorable.

17 Iron sharpens iron, and a man provokes a companion's face.

18 Whoever plants a fig tree will eat its fruits; but whoever guards his own master will be honored.

19 Just as faces are not alike to faces, so neither are humans' hearts.

20 Hades and destruction are not filled, likewise also humans' eyes are insatiable.

20 a One fixing an eye is an abomination to the Lord, and the undisciplined are unrestrained in tongue.

21 Burning is a test for silver and gold, but a man is tested through the mouth of those praising him.

21 a A lawless person's heart seeks out evil things, but an upright heart seeks out knowledge.

22 If you were to whip a senseless person in the midst of a council, dishonoring him, you would certainly not remove his senselessness.

23 You will knowingly recognize the souls of your flock and apply your heart to your herds;

24 because dominion and strength are not forever for a man, nor does he hand them down from generation to generation.

25 Attend to the green things in the plain, and you will cut grass, and gather mountain fodder,

26 so that you may have sheep for clothing; honor a plain, so that you may have lambs.

27 Son, from me you have strong utterances for your life and for the life of your attendants.

Chapter 28

1 An ungodly person flees with no one pursuing, but a righteous person has confidence like a lion.

2 Through ungodly people's sins judgments are raised, but a shrewd man will extinguish them.

3 One courageous in ungodliness extorts from poor people. Like a violent and unprofitable rain,

4 so those abandoning the law praise ungodliness, but those loving the law put a wall around themselves.

5 Evil men will not understand judgment, but those seeking the Lord will understand in everything.

6 A poor person walking in truth is better than a false rich person.

7 An understanding son keeps law; but whoever shepherds dissipation dishonors a father.

8 The one multiplying his wealth with interest and excesses gathers it for the one showing mercy to poor people.

9 The one turning aside his ear so as not to hear law has himself also made his prayer abominable.

10 Whoever leads upright people astray in an evil way will himself fall into corruption; but the lawless will pass through good things and will not enter into them.

11 A rich man is wise to himself, but an intelligent needy person will condemn him.

12 Through the help of righteous people much glory arises, but in ungodly people's places humans are caught.

13 The one covering his own ungodliness will not prosper, but the one explaining reproofs will be loved.

14 Blessed is a man who cowers before everything through reverence, but the one hard in heart will fall into evil things.

15 A hungry lion and a thirsty wolf is the one who, being poor, tyrannizes over an impoverished nation.

16 A king lacking revenues is a great extortioner, but the one hating injustice will live a long time.

17 The one guaranteeing a man under a charge of murder will be a fugitive and not in safety.

17 a Discipline a son, and he will love you and give ornament to your soul; you shall certainly not listen to a lawless nation.

18 The one walking righteously has been helped, but the one walking in crooked ways will be entangled.

19 The one working his own land will be filled with breads, but the one pursuing leisure will be filled with poverty.

20 A trustworthy man will be greatly blessed, but the evil person will not be unpunished.

21 Whoever does not respect righteous people's faces is not good; such a person will sell a man for a morsel of bread.

22 An envious man hastens to become rich and does not know that a merciful person will rule him.

23 The one reproving a human's ways will have graces more than the one flattering with a tongue.

24 Whoever rejects a father or mother and thinks he is not sinning, this person is a partner of an ungodly man.

25 An insatiable man judges at random; but whoever has trusted in the Lord will be under care.

26 Whoever has trusted in a rash heart, such a person is senseless; but whoever walks in wisdom will be saved.

27 Whoever gives to poor people will not lack; but whoever turns away his eye will be in much difficulty.

28 In ungodly people's places righteous people groan, but in those people's destruction righteous people will multiply.

Chapter 29

1 A reproving man is better than a stiff-necked man; for when he suddenly burns, there is no healing.

2 When righteous people are praised, peoples will be gladdened, but when ungodly people rule, men groan.

3 The father of a man loving wisdom is gladdened; but whoever shepherds prostitutes will destroy wealth.

4 A righteous king raises up a country, but a lawless man demolishes it.

5 Whoever prepares a net against his own friend's face puts it around his own feet.

6 For a sinning man there is a great trap, but a righteous person will be in joy and gladness.

7 A righteous person knows how to judge for the impoverished, but the ungodly person will not understand knowledge, and a discerning mind does not belong to a poor person.

8 Pestilent men burned a city, but wise people turned away anger.

9 A wise man judges nations, but a worthless man, being angry, is laughed at and does not cower.

10 Men sharing in blood will hate a holy person, but the upright will seek out his soul.

11 A senseless person brings out his whole wrath, but a wise person stores it portion by portion.

12 When a king listens to an unjust word, all those under him are lawless.

13 When a lender and debtor come together with one another, the Lord makes a visitation of both.

14 When a king judges poor people in truth, his throne will be established for a testimony.

15 Blows and reproofs give wisdom, but a wandering child shames his parents.

16 When ungodly people are many, sins become many, but righteous people become greatly afraid when those people fall.

17 Discipline your son, and he will give you rest and give ornament to your soul.

18 There will certainly not be an interpreter for a lawless nation, but the one keeping the law is blessed.

19 A harsh servant will not be disciplined by words; for even if he understands, yet he will not listen.

20 If you see a man quick in words, know that a senseless person has more hope than he.

21 Whoever lives lavishly from childhood will be a servant, and at the last will be pained over himself.

22 A wrathful man digs strife, and an irascible man dug out sins.

23 Arrogance humbles a man, but the Lord supports the humble-minded with glory.

24 Whoever shares with a thief hates his own soul; but if, when an oath has been put forth, they hear and do not report,

25 having feared and been ashamed before humans, they were tripped; but the one trusting in the Lord will be gladdened. Ungodliness gives a man a fall; but whoever has trusted in the Master will be saved.

26 Many attend upon leaders' faces, but what is just for a man comes from the Lord.

27 An unjust man is an abomination to righteous people, but a directing way is an abomination to a lawless person. – –

10 Who will find a courageous woman? And such a woman is more precious than costly stones.

11 Her husband's heart has confidence in her; such a woman will not lack good spoils;

12 for she produces good things for her husband all her life.

13 Winding wool and flax, she made it useful with her hands.

14 She became like a ship trading from afar, and she gathers livelihood.

15 And she rises from nights and gave foods to the household and tasks to the maidservants.

16 Having considered a farm, she bought it, and from fruits of her hands she planted a property.

17 Having strongly girded her loins, she braced her arms for work.

18 She tasted that working is good, and her lamp is not extinguished the whole night.

19 She stretches her forearms toward beneficial things, and braces her hands upon a spindle.

20 And she opened her hands to a needy person, and stretched out a wrist to a poor person.

21 Her husband does not worry about those in the house whenever he lingers somewhere; for all those with her are clothed.

22 She made double cloaks for her husband, and garments for herself from fine linen and purple.

23 And her husband becomes conspicuous in gates whenever he sits in council with the elder inhabitants of the land.

24 She made linen cloths and sold them, and girdles to the Chanaanites.

25 She opened her mouth attentively and lawfully and appointed order for her tongue.

26 She clothed herself in strength and comeliness and was gladdened in last days.

27 The dwellings of her houses are sheltered, and she did not eat idle foods.

28 And she opens her mouth wisely and according to law, and her mercifulness raised up her children, and they became rich, and her husband praised her:

29 Many daughters acquired wealth, many did mighty things, but you lie above and surpassed all.

30 Pleasing qualities are false and a woman's beauty vain; for an understanding woman is blessed, and let her praise fear of the Lord.

31 Give her from fruits of her hands, and let her husband be praised in gates.

Ecclesiastes

Chapter 1

1 Utterances of the Ecclesiast, son of Dauid, king of Israel in Ierousalem.

2 Vanity of vanities, said the Ecclesiast, vanity of vanities, everything is vanity.

3 What surplus is there for the human in all his toil in which he toils under the sun?

4 A generation goes and a generation comes, and the earth has stood forever.

5 And the sun rises and the sun sets and draws toward its place;

6 rising there, it goes toward the south and circles toward the north; circling it circles, the wind goes, and the wind returns upon its circuits.

7 All the torrents go into the sea, and the sea will not be filled; to the place where the torrents go, there they return to go.

8 All words are wearisome; a man will not be able to speak, and an eye will not be filled with seeing, and an ear will not be filled from hearing.

9 What has happened? The same is what will happen; and what has been done? The same is what will be done; and there is nothing fresh under the sun.

10 Whoever will speak and say, See, this is new, it has already happened in the ages that came before us.

11 There is no remembrance of the first, and indeed of the last who have come there will be no remembrance of them among those who will come at the last.

12 I, the Ecclesiast, became king over Israel in Ierousalem;

13 and I gave my heart to seek out and to examine in wisdom concerning all the things happening under heaven; because God gave an evil distraction to the sons of the human to be distracted in it.

14 I saw all the works done under the sun, and behold, everything is vanity and choice of spirit.

15 What has been perverted will not be able to be set in order, and a deficiency will not be able to be numbered.

16 I spoke in my heart, saying, I, behold, was magnified and added wisdom above all who came before me in Ierousalem, and my heart saw much, wisdom and knowledge.

17 And I gave my heart to know wisdom and knowledge; I knew parables and understanding, that indeed this too is choice of spirit;

18 because in abundance of wisdom is abundance of knowledge, and the one adding knowledge will add pain.

Chapter 2

1 I said in my heart, Come now, I will test you in gladness, and see in good; and behold, indeed this too is vanity.

2 To laughter I said, Derangement, and to gladness, Why do you do this?

3 I examined in my heart drawing my flesh into wine – and my heart guided in wisdom – and taking hold of senselessness, until I see what is the good for the sons of the human which they will do under the sun for the number of days of their life.

4 I enlarged my work, I built houses for myself, I planted vineyards for myself,

5 I made gardens and parks for myself and planted in them every fruit tree;

6 I made pools of waters for myself to water from them a wood sprouting trees;

7 I acquired male slaves and female slaves, and homeborn slaves came to belong to me, and indeed much possession of cattle and flock came to belong to me above all who came before me in Ierousalem;

8 I gathered for myself also silver and gold and abundances of kings and of countries; I made for myself male singers and female singers and delights of the sons of the human, a male wine-pourer and female wine-pourers;

9 and I was magnified and increased beyond all who came before me in Ierousalem; and indeed my wisdom stood with me.

10 And everything that my eyes asked, I did not withhold from them; I did not prevent my heart from any gladness, because my heart was gladdened in all my toil, and this became my portion from all my toil.

11 And I looked upon all my works which my hands did, and upon toil in which I toiled to do them, and behold, everything is vanity and choice of spirit, and there is no surplus under the sun.

12 And I looked to see wisdom and derangement and senselessness; because who is the human who will come after the counsel, all the things that made it?

13 And I saw that wisdom has a surplus above senselessness, as the surplus of light above darkness;

14 the wise person's eyes are in his head, and the senseless person walks in darkness. And indeed I knew that one occurrence will occur to them all.

15 And I said in my heart, As the occurrence of the senseless person, indeed it will occur to me also, and why did I become wise? I then spoke excessively in my heart, because a senseless person speaks from excess, that indeed this too is vanity.

16 Because there is no remembrance of the wise person with the senseless person forever, inasmuch as already in the coming days everything was forgotten; and how will the wise person die with the senseless person?

17 And I hated life, because the work done under the sun is evil upon me, because everything is vanity and choice of spirit.

18 And I hated all my toil which I toil under the sun, because I leave it to the human coming after me;

19 and who knows whether he will be wise or senseless? And he exercises authority over all my toil in which I toiled and in which I acted wisely under the sun. Indeed this too is vanity.

20 And I turned to renounce in my heart all the toil in which I toiled under the sun,

21 because there is a human whose toil is in wisdom and in knowledge and in courage, and to a human who did not toil in it he will give his portion. Indeed this too is vanity and great evil.

22 Because what comes to the human in all his toil and in the choice of his heart in which he himself toils under the sun?

23 Because all his days are of pains, and his distraction of wrath, and indeed at night his heart does not sleep. Indeed this too is vanity.

24 There is no good in a human; what he will eat and what he will drink and what he will show his soul is good in his toil. Indeed this too I saw, that it is from God's hand;

25 because who will eat and who will spare apart from him?

26 Because to the human good before his face he gave wisdom and knowledge and gladness; and to the sinner he gave distraction to add and to gather to give to the good person before God's face; because indeed this too is vanity and choice of spirit.

Chapter 3

1 For everything there is a time, and a season for every matter under heaven.

2 A season to give birth and a season to die, a season to plant and a season to pull out what has been planted,

3 a season to kill and a season to heal, a season to pull down and a season to build,

4 a season to weep and a season to laugh, a season to mourn and a season to dance,

5 a season to cast stones and a season to gather stones, a season to embrace and a season to be far from an embrace,

6 a season to seek and a season to lose, a season to keep and a season to cast out,

7 a season to tear and a season to sew, a season to be silent and a season to speak,

8 a season to love and a season to hate, a season of war and a season of peace.

9 What surplus has the one doing in the things in which he himself toils?

10 I saw the distraction which God gave to the sons of the human to be distracted in it.

11 He made everything good in its season, and indeed he gave eternity in their heart, so that the human may not find the work which God did, from beginning and until end.

12 I knew that there is no good in them except to be gladdened and to do good in his life;

13 and indeed every human who will eat and drink and see good in all his toil, it is God's gift.

14 I knew that everything, as much as God did, will be forever; there is no adding to it and there is no taking away from it, and God did it so that they may fear before his face.

15 What happened already is, and as much as is to happen has already happened, and God will seek the one being pursued.

16 And still I saw under the sun a place of judgment, there the ungodly person, and a place of the righteous person, there the ungodly person.

17 I said in my heart, God will judge the righteous person and the ungodly person, because there is a season for every matter and over every work.

18 There I said in my heart concerning the speech of the sons of the human, that God will distinguish them, and to show that they are beasts, indeed to themselves.

19 Because the occurrence of the sons of the human and the occurrence of the beast are one occurrence for them; as the death of this one, so the death of that one, and one spirit for all; and what surplus had the human beyond the beast? Nothing, because everything is vanity.

20 Everything goes to one place; everything came from dust, and everything returns to dust;

21 and who knows the spirit of the sons of the human, whether it ascends above, and the spirit of the beast, whether it descends below into earth?

22 And I saw that there is no good except that the human will be gladdened in his works, because that is his portion; because who will lead him to see what may happen after him?

Chapter 4

1 And I turned and saw all the oppressions happening under the sun; and behold, the tear of those being oppressed, and they have no comforter, and strength is from the hand of those oppressing them, and they have no comforter.

2 And I praised the dead who had already died above the living, as many as themselves live until now;

3 and better than these two is whoever has not yet come to be, who did not see the evil work done under the sun.

4 And I saw all toil and all prowess of the work, that it is a man's envy from his companion; indeed this too is vanity and choice of spirit.

5 The senseless person folded his hands and ate his flesh.

6 A handful of rest is better than two handfuls of toil and choice of spirit.

7 And I turned and saw vanity under the sun.

8 There is one, and there is no second, and indeed he has neither son nor brother; and there is no end to all his toil, and indeed his eye is not filled with wealth. And for whom do I toil and deprive my soul of goodness? Indeed this too is vanity and an evil distraction.

9 The two are better than the one, who have a good reward in their toil;

10 because if they fall, the one will raise his partner, and woe to him who is one, whenever he falls and there is no second to raise him.

11 And indeed if two sleep, there is also warmth for them; and how may the one be warmed?

12 And if the one is overpowered, the two will stand against him, and the threefold cord will not quickly be torn apart.

13 A needy and wise child is better than an older and senseless king who did not know how to attend any longer;

14 because from a house of prisoners he will come out to reign, because indeed in his kingdom he was born needy.

15 I saw all the living walking under the sun with the second young man who will stand in his place,

16 there is no end to all the people, to all, as many as came before them; and indeed the last will not be gladdened in him; because indeed this too is vanity and choice of spirit.

17 Guard your foot whenever you go into God's house, and be near to hearing; your sacrifice is above a gift of senseless people, because they do not know how to do evil.

Chapter 5

1 Do not hasten with your mouth, and let your heart not hurry to bring forth a word before God's face; because God is in heaven and you upon earth, therefore let your words be few.

2 Because a dream comes in abundance of distraction, and a senseless person's voice in abundance of words.

3 Whenever you vow a vow to God, do not delay repaying it; because there is no pleasure in senseless people; repay whatever you vow.

4 It is better for you not to vow than for you to vow and not repay.

5 Do not give your mouth to make your flesh sin, and do not say before God's face that it is ignorance, so that God may not be angered at your voice and destroy the works of your hands.

6 Because in abundance of dreams are also vanities and many words; because fear God.

7 If you see oppression of a needy person and seizure of judgment and righteousness in a country, do not marvel at the matter; because a high one above a high one is to watch, and high ones over them.

8 And the surplus of land is in everything, a king of the cultivated field.

9 One loving silver will not be filled with silver; and who loved produce in their abundance? Indeed this too is vanity.

10 In abundance of goodness those eating it were multiplied; and what prowess has the one possessing it except to see with his eyes?

11 A slave's sleep is sweet, whether he eats little or much; and for the one filled with becoming rich there is nothing allowing him to sleep.

12 There is a sickness which I saw under the sun, wealth being kept by its possessor to his harm,

13 and that wealth will perish in an evil distraction, and he begot a son, and there is nothing in his hand.

14 As he came out naked from his mother's womb, he will return to go as he comes, and he will take nothing in his toil to go in his hand.

15 Indeed this too is an evil sickness; for just as he came, so also he will go away, and what surplus has he in that he toils for wind?

16 And indeed all his days are in darkness and mourning and much wrath and sickness and anger.

17 Behold what I saw as good, what is fine: to eat and to drink and to see goodness in all his toil in which he may toil under the sun for the number of days of his life which God gave him; because that is his portion.

18 And indeed every human to whom God gave wealth and possessions and empowered him to eat from it and to take his share and to be gladdened in his toil, this is God's gift.

19 Because he will not much remember the days of his life; because God distracts him in gladness of his heart.

Chapter 6

1 There is an evil which I saw under the sun, and it is great upon the human;

2 a man to whom God will give wealth and possessions and glory, and he is not lacking for his soul in any of the things he will desire, and God will not empower him to eat from it, because a strange man will eat it; this is vanity and an evil sickness.

3 If a man begets a hundred and will live many years, and however many the days of his years will be, and his soul will not be filled with goodness, and indeed no burial came to him, I said, The miscarriage is better than he,

4 because it came in vanity and goes in darkness, and in darkness its name will be covered,

5 and indeed it did not see the sun and did not know; there is rest for this one beyond that one.

6 And if he lived courses of a thousand years and did not see goodness, does not everything go to one place?

7 All the human's toil is for his mouth, and indeed the soul will not be filled.

8 Because what surplus has the wise person above the senseless person? Because the needy person knows how to walk before life.

9 A sight of eyes is better than what goes in the soul. Indeed this too is vanity and choice of spirit.

10 If anything happened, its name has already been called, and it was known what a human is, and he will not be able to contend in judgment with the one stronger than he;

11 because there are many words multiplying vanity. What surplus has the human?

12 Because who knows what is good for the human in life, for the number of days of the life of his vanity? And he made them in a shadow; because who will tell the human what will be after him under the sun?

Chapter 7

1 A good name is better than good oil, and a day of death than the day of his birth.

2 It is better to go into a house of mourning than to go into a house of drinking, inasmuch as this is the end of every human, and the living person will put it into his heart.

3 Wrath is better than laughter, because in badness of face a heart will be made good.

4 Wise people's heart is in a house of mourning, and senseless people's heart in a house of gladness.

5 To hear a wise person's rebuke is better than a man hearing a song of senseless people;

6 because as the sound of thorns under a cauldron, so is the laughter of senseless people; indeed this too is vanity.

7 Because oppression deranges a wise person and destroys the heart of his vigor.

8 The last of words is better than its beginning; a long-tempered person is better than one lofty in spirit.

9 Do not hasten in your spirit to be wrathful, because wrath will rest in senseless people's bosom.

10 Do not say, What happened, that the former days were better than these? Because you did not ask about this in wisdom.

11 Wisdom is good with an inheritance, and a surplus for those beholding the sun;

12 because wisdom in its shadow is like the shadow of silver, and a surplus of the knowledge of wisdom will give life to its possessor.

13 See God's works; because who will be able to set in order the one whom God may pervert?

14 On a day of goodness live in good, and on a day of evil see; indeed God made this in accord with that concerning speech, so that the human may find nothing after him.

15 I saw everything in the days of my vanity; there is a righteous person perishing in his righteousness, and there is an ungodly person remaining in his wickedness.

16 Do not become greatly righteous and do not act excessively wise, lest you be astounded.

17 Do not act greatly ungodly and do not become harsh, so that you may not die when it is not your season.

18 It is good for you to hold fast to this, and indeed do not release your hand from that, because the one fearing God will come out of everything.

19 Wisdom will help the wise person above ten persons exercising authority who are in the city;

20 because there is no righteous human on the earth who will do good and will not sin.

21 And indeed do not set your heart upon all the words they will speak, so that you may not hear your slave cursing you,

22 because very often he will act wickedly against you and on many occasions harm your heart, as indeed you too cursed others.

23 I tested all these things in wisdom; I said, I will be made wise,

24 and it went far from me beyond what it was, and a deep depth, who will find it?

25 I circled, and my heart, to know and to examine and seek wisdom and reckoning and to know an ungodly person's senselessness and harshness and derangement.

26 And I find more bitter than death the woman who is snares, and her heart nets, her hands bonds; the good person before God's face will be rescued from her, and a sinner will be caught in her.

27 See, this I found, said the Ecclesiast, one by one to find a reasoning,

28 which my soul still sought and I did not find; one human from a thousand I found, and a woman among all these I did not find.

29 Only see, this I found, that God made the human upright, and they sought many reasonings.

Chapter 8

1 Who knows wise people? And who knows the solution of an utterance? A human's wisdom will illuminate his face, and one shameless in his face will be hated.

2 Keep a king's mouth, and concerning a word of an oath of God do not hasten;

3 you will go from his face; do not stand in an evil word; because everything that he may wish he will do,

4 as a king exercising authority speaks, and who will say to him, What will you do?

5 The one keeping a commandment will not know an evil utterance, and a wise person's heart knows a season of judgment;

6 because for every matter there is a season and judgment, because the human's knowledge is great upon him;

7 because he does not know what will be, because who will tell him how it will be?

8 There is no human exercising authority over spirit to restrain the spirit; and there is no authority on the day of death, and there is no discharge in war, and ungodliness will not preserve its possessor.

9 And all this I saw and gave my heart to every work that has been done under the sun, all the things in which the human exercised authority over a human to harm him;

10 and then I saw ungodly people brought into tombs, and they went from a holy place and were praised in the city because they did thus. Indeed this too is vanity.

11 Because contradiction does not arise quickly from those doing evil; therefore the heart of the sons of the human was fully assured in them to do evil.

12 The one who sinned did evil from then and from length of time for him; because indeed I know that it will be good for those fearing God, so that they may fear before his face;

13 and it will not be good for the ungodly person, and he will not lengthen days in a shadow, who does not fear before God's face.

14 There is vanity which has been done upon earth, that there are righteous people to whom it comes as the work of ungodly people, and there are ungodly people to whom it comes as the work of righteous people; I said that indeed this too is vanity.

15 And I praised gladness, because there is no good for the human under the sun except to eat and to drink and to be gladdened, and it will accompany him in his toil for the days of his life, as many as God gave him under the sun.

16 When I gave my heart to know wisdom and to see the distraction that has been made upon the earth, because indeed by day and by night he does not see sleep in his eyes,

17 and I saw all God's works, that a human will not be able to find the work done under the sun; however much the human may toil to seek, he will not find; and indeed however much the wise person may say that he knows, he will not be able to find.

Chapter 9

1 Because I put all this into my heart, and my heart saw all this, that the righteous and the wise and their labors are in God's hand, and indeed the human does not know either love or hatred; everything is before their face,

2 vanity in everything. One occurrence for the righteous person and the ungodly person, for the good and the evil and the clean and the unclean and the one sacrificing and the one not sacrificing; as the good person, so the sinner; as the one swearing, so the one fearing the oath.

3 This is evil in everything done under the sun, that there is one occurrence for all; and indeed the heart of the sons of the human was filled with evil, and derangement is in their heart in their life, and after them, toward the dead.

4 Because who is the one sharing with all the living? There is hope, because the living dog is itself better than the dead lion.

5 Because the living will know that they will die, and the dead do not know anything; and they have no reward any longer, because their remembrance was forgotten;

6 and indeed their love and their hatred and their jealousy have already perished, and they have no portion any longer forever in everything done under the sun.

7 Come, eat your bread in gladness and drink your wine with a good heart, because God has already approved your works.

8 At every season let your garments be white, and let oil upon your head not be lacking.

9 See life with a woman whom you loved all the days of the life of your vanity given to you under the sun, all the days of your vanity, because that is your portion in your life and in your toil in which you toil under the sun.

10 Everything, as much as your hand may find to do, do according to your power, because there is no work and reasoning and knowledge and wisdom in Hades, where you are going.

11 I turned and saw under the sun that the race is not for the swift, and war not for the powerful, and indeed bread not for the wise, and indeed wealth not for the understanding, and indeed grace not for those knowing, because a season and an encounter will occur to them all.

12 Because indeed the human did not know his season; as the fish caught in an evil casting-net and as birds caught in a trap, like them the sons of the human are trapped at an evil season whenever it falls upon them suddenly.

13 Indeed this too I saw as wisdom under the sun, and it is great to me;

14 a small city and few men in it, and a great king may come against it and encircle it and build great siegeworks against it;

15 and he may find in it a needy wise man, and he himself will preserve the city in his wisdom; and no human remembered that needy man.

16 And I said, Wisdom is better than power; and the needy person's wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.

17 Words of wise people in rest are heard above the cry of those exercising authority in senselessnesses.

18 Wisdom is better than implements of war, and one sinner will destroy much goodness.

Chapter 10

1 Flies that kill will rot a preparation of fragrant oil; a little wisdom is precious above glory of great senselessness.

2 A wise person's heart is toward his right, and a senseless person's heart toward his left;

3 and indeed on a way whenever a senseless person walks, his heart will lack, and everything he will reckon is senselessness.

4 If the spirit of the one exercising authority rises against you, do not leave your place, because healing will stop great sins.

5 There is an evil which I saw under the sun, like an involuntary thing which came from the face of the one exercising authority;

6 the senseless person was set in great heights, and rich people will sit in a low place;

7 I saw slaves on horses and rulers walking like slaves upon the earth.

8 The one digging a pit will fall into it, and the one pulling down a fence, a snake will bite him;

9 one removing stones will be distressed by them, one splitting wood will be endangered by it.

10 If the iron falls out, and he himself disturbed its face, he will also strengthen forces, and wisdom is the courageous person's surplus.

11 If the snake bites without whispering, there is also no surplus for the one chanting a charm.

12 Words of a wise person's mouth are grace, and a senseless person's lips will drown him;

13 the beginning of his mouth's words is senselessness, and the last of his mouth evil derangement;

14 and the senseless person multiplies words. The human did not know what happened, and what will be after him, who will tell him?

15 The toil of senseless people will weary them, one who did not know how to go to a city.

16 Woe to you, city, whose king is younger and whose rulers eat in the morning;

17 blessed are you, land, whose king is a son of free people and whose rulers will eat at a season in strength and will not be ashamed.

18 Through slothfulnesses the framework will be lowered, and through idleness of hands the house will drip.

19 For laughter they make bread, and wine gladdens the living, and everything will heed silver.

20 And indeed in your consciousness do not curse a king, and in chambers of your bedrooms do not curse a rich person; because a bird of heaven will carry away the voice, and the one having wings will report a word.

Chapter 11

1 Send your bread upon the face of the water, because in abundance of days you will find it;

2 give a portion to the seven and indeed to the eight, because you do not know what evil will be upon the earth.

3 If the clouds are filled with rain, they pour out upon the earth; and if a tree falls in the south and if in the north, in the place where the tree will fall, there it will be.

4 One watching wind will not sow, and one looking among the clouds will not reap,

5 when he does not know what the way of the spirit is. As bones in the womb of her who carries a child, so you will not know God's works, as much as he will do, everything.

6 In the morning sow your seed, and toward evening let your hand not cease, because you do not know which will succeed, whether this or that, and whether the two together are good.

7 And light is sweet, and it is good for the eyes to see the sun;

8 because even if the human will live many years, in all of them he will be gladdened and will remember the days of darkness, because they will be many; everything coming is vanity.

9 Be gladdened, young man, in your youth, and let your heart make you glad in the days of your youth, and walk in ways of your heart and in the sight of your eyes, and know that for all these things God will bring you into judgment.

10 And remove wrath from your heart and turn evil away from your flesh, because youth and unintelligence are vanity.

Chapter 12

1 And remember the one who created you in the days of your youth, before the days of evil come and years arrive in which you will say, I have no pleasure in them;

2 before the sun and the light and the moon and the stars are darkened, and the clouds return after the rain;

3 on a day when guards of the house may be shaken and men of strength bent, and the women grinding ceased, because they became few, and the women looking through the openings will grow dark;

4 and they will close doors in the marketplace in the weakness of the voice of the woman grinding, and he will rise at the voice of the sparrow, and all the daughters of song will be lowered;

5 and indeed they will see from a height, and terrors are on the way; and the almond may blossom, and the locust grow fat, and the caper be scattered, because the human went to the house of his eternity, and the mourners circled in the marketplace;

6 before a silver cord is overturned, and a golden flower ornament crushed, and a water jar shattered at the spring, and the wheel run together upon the pit,

7 and the dust return to the earth as it was, and the spirit return to God who gave it.

8 Vanity of vanities, said the Ecclesiast, everything is vanity.

9 And furthermore, because the Ecclesiast became wise, he still taught the people knowledge, and an ear will trace out an orderly arrangement of parables.

10 The Ecclesiast sought much to find words of pleasure and what has been written of uprightness, words of truth.

11 Words of wise people are like the ox-goads and like planted nails, which from the collections were given from one shepherd, and a surplus from them.

12 My son, guard yourself against making many books; there is no end, and much study is weariness of flesh.

13 The end of a word, the whole is heard: Fear God and keep his commandments, because this is the whole human.

14 Because God will bring every work into judgment, in everything overlooked, whether good or evil.

Song of Solomon

Chapter 1

1 Song of songs, which belongs to Salomon.

2 Let him kiss me with kisses of his mouth, because your breasts are better than wine,

3 and the fragrance of your ointments above all the spices; your name is ointment poured out. Therefore young women loved you,

4 they drew you; after you we will run into the fragrance of your ointments. The king brought me into his chamber. Let us exult and be gladdened in you; we will love your breasts above wine; uprightness loved you.

5 I am black and beautiful, daughters of Ierousalem, like tents of Kedar, like tent curtains of Salomon.

6 Do not look at me because I am blackened, because the sun looked upon me; sons of my mother fought against me, they set me as a keeper in vineyards; my own vineyard I did not keep.

7 Tell me, you whom my soul loved, where you shepherd, where you bed down at midday, lest I become like a veiled woman beside your companions' herds.

8 If you do not know yourself, beautiful one among women, go out on the heels of the flocks and shepherd your young she-goats beside the shepherds' tents.

9 To my mare among Pharao's chariots I likened you, my neighbor.

10 How were your cheeks made beautiful like turtledoves, your neck like little necklaces?

11 We will make likenesses of gold for you with dots of silver.

12 While the king was at his reclining, my nard gave its fragrance.

13 My kinsman is a bundle of myrrh to me; he will lodge between my breasts;

14 my kinsman is a cluster of henna to me in vineyards of Engaddi.

15 Behold, you are beautiful, my neighbor, behold, you are beautiful; your eyes are doves.

16 Behold, you are beautiful, my kinsman, and indeed lovely; moreover our bed is shaded,

17 the beams of our houses are cedars, our paneled ceilings cypresses.

Chapter 2

1 I am a flower of the plain, a lily of the valleys.

2 Like a lily in the midst of thorns, so is my neighbor among the daughters.

3 Like an apple tree among the trees of the wood, so is my kinsman among the sons; in his shade I desired and sat, and his fruit is sweet in my throat.

4 Bring me into a house of wine; set love over me.

5 Support me with mulberries, heap apples around me, because I am wounded with love.

6 His left hand is under my head, and his right hand will embrace me.

7 I adjured you, daughters of Ierousalem, by the powers and by the strengths of the field, not to awaken and rouse love until it wishes.

8 The voice of my kinsman; behold, he comes leaping upon the mountains, bounding upon the hills.

9 My kinsman is like the gazelle or a fawn of deer upon the mountains of Baithel. Behold, he stands behind our wall, peering through the windows, looking out through the lattices.

10 My kinsman answers and says to me, Rise, come, my neighbor, my beautiful one, my dove,

11 because behold, winter passed, the rain departed, it went away,

12 the flowers appeared on the earth, the season of pruning has arrived, the voice of the turtledove was heard in our land,

13 the fig tree brought forth its unripe figs, the vines blossom, they gave fragrance. Rise, come, my neighbor, my beautiful one, my dove,

14 and come, my dove in the shelter of the rock adjoining the outer wall; show me your appearance and make me hear your voice, because your voice is pleasant and your appearance lovely.

15 Catch for us little foxes destroying vineyards, and our vines blossom.

16 My kinsman belongs to me, and I to him, the one shepherding among the lilies,

17 until the day breathes through and the shadows move. Turn, be like the gazelle or a fawn of deer, my kinsman, upon mountains of hollows.

Chapter 3

1 Upon my bed at nights I sought him whom my soul loved; I sought him and did not find him, I called him and he did not listen to me.

2 I will rise now and circle in the city, in the marketplaces and in the broad streets, and seek him whom my soul loved; I sought him and did not find him.

3 The watchmen circling in the city found me: Did you see him whom my soul loved?

4 It was a little while after I passed from them until I found him whom my soul loved; I held him and will not let him go until I brought him into my mother's house and into the chamber of her who conceived me.

5 I adjured you, daughters of Ierousalem, by the powers and by the strengths of the field, not to awaken and rouse love until it wishes.

6 Who is this woman ascending from the wilderness like stems of smoke, perfumed with myrrh and frankincense from all a perfumer's powders?

7 Behold, Salomon's bed, sixty mighty men around it from Israel's mighty men,

8 all holding a sword, taught war, each man with his sword upon his thigh because of terror at nights.

9 King Salomon made himself a litter from trees of Lebanon,

10 he made its pillars silver and its reclining place golden, its mounting place purple, its inside paved with stones, love from daughters of Ierousalem.

11 Go out and look upon King Salomon in the crown with which his mother crowned him on the day of his wedding and on the day of gladness of his heart.

Chapter 4

1 Behold, you are beautiful, my neighbor, behold, you are beautiful. Your eyes are doves outside your silence. Your hair is like herds of goats which were revealed from Galaad.

2 Your teeth are like herds of shorn sheep which ascended from the washing, all bearing twins, and there is none childless among them.

3 Your lips are like the scarlet cord, and your speech is lovely. Your cheek is like the rind of the pomegranate outside your silence.

4 Your neck is like Dauid's tower built for thalpioth; a thousand shields hang upon it, all the mighty men's missiles.

5 Your two breasts are like two twin fawns of a gazelle grazing among lilies.

6 Until the day breathes through and the shadows move, I will go to the mountain of myrrh and to the hill of Lebanon.

7 You are wholly beautiful, my neighbor, and there is no blemish in you.

8 Come from Lebanon, bride, come from Lebanon; you will come and pass through from the beginning of faith, from the summit of Sanir and Hermon, from lions' dens, from leopards' mountains.

9 You heartened us, my sister, bride, you heartened us with one of your eyes, with one ornament of your neck.

10 How were your breasts made beautiful, my sister, bride, how were your breasts made more beautiful than wine? And the fragrance of your garments is above all the spices.

11 Your lips drip a honeycomb, bride, honey and milk are under your tongue, and the fragrance of your garments is like the fragrance of Lebanon.

12 My sister, bride, is a locked garden, a locked garden, a sealed spring;

13 your shoots are a park of pomegranates with fruit of fruit trees, henna with nards,

14 nard and saffron, reed and cinnamon with all the trees of Lebanon, myrrh, aloth, with all the foremost ointments,

15 a spring of gardens, a well of living water rushing from Lebanon.

16 Awake, north, and come, south, blow through my garden, and let my spices flow; let my kinsman descend into his garden and eat the fruit of his fruit trees.

Chapter 5

1 I entered my garden, my sister, bride, I harvested my myrrh with my spices, I ate my bread with my honey, I drank my wine with my milk; eat, neighbors, and drink and become drunk, brothers,

2 I sleep, and my heart is awake. The voice of my kinsman, he knocks upon the door: Open to me, my sister, my neighbor, my dove, my perfect one, because my head was filled with dew and my locks with drops of night.

3 I took off my tunic; how should I put it on? I washed my feet; how will I soil them?

4 My kinsman sent his hand from the opening, and my belly was stirred over him.

5 I rose to open to my kinsman; my hands dripped myrrh, my fingers abundant myrrh upon the handles of the bolt.

6 I opened to my kinsman; my kinsman passed by; my soul went out at his word; I sought him and did not find him, I called him and he did not listen to me.

7 The guards circling in the city found me, they struck me, they wounded me; the guards of the walls took my veil away from me.

8 I adjured you, daughters of Ierousalem, by the powers and by the strengths of the field, if you find my kinsman, what should you tell him? That I am wounded with love.

9 What is your kinsman beyond a kinsman, beautiful one among women, what is your kinsman beyond a kinsman, that you adjured us thus?

10 My kinsman is white and red, chosen out from myriads;

11 his head is gold and phaz, his locks fir trees, black as a raven,

12 his eyes like doves upon fullnesses of waters, washed in milk, sitting upon fullnesses of waters,

13 his cheeks like bowls of spice growing perfuming substances, his lips lilies dripping abundant myrrh,

14 his hands golden carved works filled with tharsis, his belly an ivory box upon sapphire stone,

15 his legs marble pillars founded upon golden bases, his appearance like Lebanon, choice as cedars,

16 his throat sweetnesses, and he is wholly desire; this is my kinsman and this my neighbor, daughters of Ierousalem.

Chapter 6

1 Where did your kinsman go, beautiful one among women? Where did your kinsman look away? And we will seek him with you.

2 My kinsman descended into his garden, to bowls of spice, to shepherd in gardens and gather lilies;

3 I belong to my kinsman, and my kinsman to me, the one shepherding among the lilies.

4 You are beautiful, my neighbor, like good pleasure, lovely like Ierousalem, a terror like women drawn up in order.

5 Turn your eyes away from before me, because they gave me wings. Your hair is like herds of goats which appeared from Galaad.

6 Your teeth are like herds of shorn sheep which ascended from the washing, all bearing twins, and there is none childless among them.

7 Your lips are like the scarlet cord, and your speech is lovely. Your cheek is like the rind of the pomegranate outside your silence.

8 There are sixty queens and eighty concubines and young women who have no number.

9 My dove, my perfect one, is one; she is the one for her mother, she is chosen for her who bore her. Daughters saw her and will call her blessed, queens and concubines, and will praise her.

10 Who is this woman looking out like dawn, beautiful like the moon, choice like the sun, a terror like women drawn up in order?

11 I descended into a walnut garden to look among the torrent's produce, to see whether the vine blossomed, the pomegranates flowered; there I will give you my breasts.

12 My soul did not know; chariots of Aminadab set me.

Chapter 7

1 Return, return, Soulamite, return, return, and we will look upon you. What will you look upon in the Soulamite? She comes like dances of the camps.

2 How were your steps made lovely in sandals, daughter of Nadab? The curves of your thighs are like little necklaces, a work of an artisan's hands;

3 your navel is a carved mixing bowl not lacking mixed wine; your belly is a heap of grain fenced with lilies;

4 your two breasts are like two twin fawns of a gazelle;

5 your neck is like an ivory tower; your eyes like pools in Esebon at the gates of a daughter of many; your nose like a tower of Lebanon watching the face of Damascus;

6 your head upon you is like Carmel, and the braid of your head like purple, a king bound in galleries.

7 How were you made lovely and how were you made pleasant, love, in your delights?

8 This stature of yours was likened to the palm tree, and your breasts to the clusters.

9 I said, I will ascend the palm tree, I will hold its heights, and now your breasts will be like clusters of the vine, and the fragrance of your nose like apples

10 and your throat like the good wine going to my kinsman in uprightness, sufficing for my lips and teeth.

11 I belong to my kinsman, and his turning is toward me.

12 Come, my kinsman, let us go out into a field, let us lodge in villages;

13 let us rise early for vineyards, let us see whether the vine blossomed, the blossom blossomed, the pomegranates blossomed; there I will give you my breasts.

14 The mandrakes gave fragrance, and at our doors are all fruits of fruit trees, new alongside old, my kinsman, I kept them for you.

Chapter 8

1 Who might give you as my kinsman, nursing at my mother's breasts? Finding you outside, I will kiss you, and indeed they will not despise me.

2 I will take you along, I will bring you into my mother's house and into the chamber of her who conceived me; I will give you drink from the perfumed wine, from the juice of my pomegranates.

3 His left hand is under my head, and his right hand will embrace me.

4 I adjured you, daughters of Ierousalem, by the powers and by the strengths of the field, why should you awaken and why should you rouse love until it wishes?

5 Who is this woman ascending, whitened, leaning upon her kinsman? Under an apple tree I roused you; there your mother travailed with you, there she who bore you travailed with you.

6 Set me as a seal upon your heart, as a seal upon your arm; because love is mighty as death, jealousy harsh as Hades; its wings are wings of fire, its flames;

7 Much water will not be able to extinguish love, and rivers will not flood it; if a man gives his whole livelihood in love, they will despise him with contempt.

8 We have a little sister, and she has no breasts; what should we do for our sister on a day when she may be spoken of?

9 If she is a wall, let us build silver battlements upon her; and if she is a door, let us outline a cedar plank upon her.

10 I am a wall, and my breasts like towers; I was in his eyes like one finding peace.

11 Salomon had a vineyard in Beelamon; he gave his vineyard to the keepers; each man will bring a thousand of silver for its fruit.

12 My vineyard, my own, is before me; the thousand are for you, Salomon, and the two hundred for those keeping its fruit.

13 You who sit in gardens, companions attend to your voice; make me hear.

14 Flee, my kinsman, and be like the gazelle or the fawn of the deer upon mountains of spices.

Job

Chapter 1

1 There was a certain human in the country of Ausitis whose name was Iob, and that human was true, blameless, righteous, God-revering, abstaining from every evil matter.

2 And seven sons and three daughters came to belong to him.

3 And his livestock were seven thousand sheep, three thousand camels, five hundred pairs of oxen, five hundred grazing female donkeys, and he had very much service and great works upon the earth; and that human was noble among those from the sun's risings.

4 And his sons, going together to one another, made a drinking feast each day, taking along together also their three sisters to eat and drink with them.

5 And whenever the days of the drinking feast were completed, Iob sent and purified them, rising in the morning, and offered sacrifices for them according to their number and one calf for sin for their souls; for Iob said, Lest my sons in their thought conceived evil things toward God. Thus therefore Iob did all the days.

6 And when this day came, behold, God's angels came to stand before the Lord, and the devil came with them.

7 And the Lord said to the devil, From where have you come? And answering the Lord, the devil said, Having gone around the earth and walked about what is under heaven, I am here.

8 And the Lord said to him, Did you attend in your thought to my servant Iob, because there is no human like him among those upon the earth, blameless, true, God-revering, abstaining from every evil matter?

9 And the devil answered and said before the Lord, Does Iob revere God for nothing?

10 Did you not fence around his outside and the inside of his house and the outside of everything belonging to him round about? You blessed the works of his hands and made his livestock many upon the earth.

11 But send forth your hand and touch everything he has; surely he will bless you to your face.

12 Then the Lord said to the devil, Behold, everything belonging to him I give into your hand, but do not touch him. And the devil went out from the Lord.

13 And it was on this day that Iob's sons and his daughters were drinking wine in the house of their older brother.

14 And behold, a messenger came to Iob and said to him, The pairs of oxen were plowing, and the female donkeys grazing beside them;

15 and the captors came and took them captive and killed the servants with swords; but I alone, having been saved, came to tell you.

16 While this one was still speaking, another messenger came and said to Iob, Fire fell from heaven and burned the sheep and likewise devoured the shepherds; and I alone, having been saved, came to tell you.

17 While this one was still speaking, another messenger came and said to Iob, The horsemen made three bands against us and encircled the camels and took them captive and killed the servants with swords; but I alone was saved and came to tell you.

18 While this one was still speaking, another messenger comes, saying to Iob, While your sons and your daughters were eating and drinking at their older brother's,

19 suddenly a great wind came from the wilderness and touched the four corners of the house, and the house fell upon your children, and they died; but I alone was saved and came to tell you.

20 Thus Iob rose and tore his garments and sheared the hair of his head and fell to the ground and worshiped and said,

21 I myself came out naked from my mother's belly, and naked I will also go away there; the Lord gave, the Lord took away; as it seemed good to the Lord, so it also happened; may the Lord's name be blessed.

22 In all these things that had happened to him, Iob sinned in nothing before the Lord and did not give senselessness to God.

Chapter 2

1 And it happened on this day that God's angels came to stand before the Lord, and the devil came in their midst to stand before the Lord.

2 And the Lord said to the devil, From where do you come? Then the devil said before the Lord, Having passed through what is under heaven and walked about the whole of it, I am here.

3 And the Lord said to the devil, Did you therefore attend to my attendant Iob, because there is no human like him among those upon the earth, innocent, true, blameless, God-revering, abstaining from every evil? And he still holds to innocence; but you said to destroy his possessions for nothing.

4 And taking it up, the devil said to the Lord, Skin for skin; everything belonging to a human he will pay out for his soul;

5 nevertheless, send forth your hand and touch his bones and his flesh; surely he will bless you to your face.

6 And the Lord said to the devil, Behold, I hand him over to you; only preserve his soul.

7 And the devil went out from the Lord and struck Iob with an evil sore from feet to head.

8 And he took a potsherd to scrape the discharge, and sat upon the dung heap outside the city.

9 And when much time had passed, his wife said to him, Until when will you endure, saying, 9a Behold, I wait a little time still, expecting the hope of my salvation? 9b For behold, your memorial has vanished from the earth, sons and daughters, birth pangs and pains of my belly, for whom I labored in vain with toils. 9c And you yourself sit in the putrefaction of worms, spending the night in the open air; 9d and I am a wanderer and servant, going around from place to place and house to house, waiting for the sun, when it will set, so that I may rest from the toils and pains which now constrain me. 9e But say some utterance to the Lord and die.

10 But looking at her, he said to her, You spoke like one of the senseless women; if we received good things from the Lord's hand, shall we not bear evil things? In all these things that had happened to him, Iob sinned in nothing with his lips before God.

11 And his three friends, having heard all the evil things that came upon him, came to him, each from his own country, Eliphas the king of the Thaimans, Baldad the tyrant of the Sauchites, Sophar the king of the Minaites, and they came to him with one accord to comfort and visit him.

12 And seeing him from far away, they did not recognize him, and shouting with a loud voice they wept, each tearing his own robe and sprinkling earth upon themselves.

13 They sat beside him seven days and seven nights, and none of them spoke; for they saw that the blow was terrible and very great.

Chapter 3

1 After this Iob opened his mouth

2 and cursed his day, saying,

3 May the day perish on which I was born, and the night in which they said, Behold, a male.

4 May that day be darkness, and may the Lord not seek it out from above, nor brightness come into it;

5 and may darkness and a shadow of death take it, may gloom come upon it.

6 May that day and night be cursed, may darkness carry it away; may it not be among days of a year, nor be numbered among days of months;

7 but may that night be pain, and may neither gladness nor joy come upon it;

8 but may the one cursing that day curse it, the one about to subdue the great sea creature.

9 May the stars of that night be darkened, may it wait and not come into illumination and not see the morning star rising,

10 because it did not shut the gates of my mother's womb; for it would have removed trouble from my eyes.

11 For why did I not die in the belly, but came out from the womb and did not immediately perish?

12 And why did knees meet me? And why did I nurse at breasts?

13 Now, having lain down, I would have been quiet, and having slept, I would have rested

14 with kings, counselors of earth, who exulted over swords,

15 or with rulers whose gold was much, who filled their houses with silver,

16 or like a miscarriage coming out from a mother's womb, or like infants who did not see light.

17 There ungodly people burned out a fury of anger, there those exhausted in body rested;

18 and with one accord the everlasting ones did not hear a tax collector's voice;

19 small and great are there, and an attendant not fearing his master.

20 For why has light been given to those in bitterness, and life to souls in pains?

21 Who yearn for death and do not obtain it, digging it out like treasures,

22 and became exceedingly glad if they should attain it.

23 Death is a rest for a man, for God shut in against him;

24 for before my foods a groan comes to me, and I weep, constrained by fear;

25 for the fear which I pondered came to me, and what I had feared met me.

26 Neither was I at peace nor was I quiet nor did I rest, but anger came to me.

Chapter 4

1 And taking it up, Eliphas the Thaimanite says,

2 Has it not often been spoken to you in weariness? And who will bear the strength of your utterances?

3 For if you admonished many and encouraged a weak person's hands

4 and raised up weak people with utterances and put confidence around powerless knees,

5 but now trouble comes upon you and touched you, and you were agitated.

6 Is not your fear in senselessness, and your hope and the innocence of your way?

7 Remember therefore who, being clean, perished, or when true people perished root and all.

8 In the way I saw those plowing improper things, those sowing them will reap pains for themselves.

9 From the Lord's command they will perish, and from the breath of his anger they will vanish.

10 A lion's might and a lioness's voice and dragons' exultation were extinguished;

11 the ant-lion perished through not having food, and lions' cubs left one another.

12 And if any true utterance had occurred in your words, none of these evils would have met you. Will my ear not receive extraordinary things from him?

13 And fears and a nocturnal sound, fear falling upon humans,

14 and shuddering met me and trembling and greatly shook my bones,

15 and a spirit came upon my face, and my hair and flesh bristled.

16 I stood up and did not recognize; I saw, and there was no form before my eyes, but I heard only a breeze and a voice:

17 For what? Will a mortal be clean before the Lord, or a man blameless from his works?

18 If he does not trust his servants, and conceived something crooked against his angels,

19 and those dwelling in clay houses, from whom we ourselves also are of the same clay, he struck them in the manner of a moth;

20 and from morning until evening they are no longer; through not being able to help themselves they perished;

21 for he blew upon them and they were dried up, they perished through not having wisdom.

Chapter 5

1 And call, if anyone will listen to you, or if you will see any of the holy angels.

2 For anger also kills a senseless person, and jealousy puts an erring person to death.

3 And I have seen senseless people putting down a root, but immediately their dwelling was devoured.

4 May their sons be far from salvation, and may they be crushed at inferior people's doors, and there will be no rescuer;

5 for what they gathered, righteous people will eat, but they themselves will not be rescued from evils; may their strength be siphoned out.

6 For weariness will certainly not come out from the earth, nor will trouble sprout from mountains;

7 but a human is born for weariness, and a vulture's young fly in the heights.

8 Nevertheless I will beseech the Lord, and I will call upon the Lord, the Master of all,

9 the one doing great and untraceable things, glorious and extraordinary things which have no number;

10 the one giving rain upon the earth, sending water upon what is under heaven;

11 the one making lowly people high and rousing those who have perished;

12 altering shrewd people's counsels, and their hands will certainly not do what is true.

13 The one catching wise people in prudence, and he confounded the counsel of those with many intrigues;

14 by day darkness will meet them, and at midday may they grope as at night.

15 And may they perish in war, but may a powerless person come out from a ruler's hand;

16 and may a powerless person have hope, but may an unjust person's mouth be blocked.

17 And blessed is a human whom the Lord reproved; and do not refuse an admonition of the Almighty.

18 For he himself makes one suffer and restores again; he struck, and his hands healed.

19 Six times he will rescue you from necessities, and at the seventh evil will certainly not touch you.

20 In famine he will deliver you from death, and in war he will release you from the hand of iron.

21 He will hide you from the scourge of a tongue, and you will certainly not fear coming evils.

22 You will laugh at unjust and lawless people, and you will certainly not fear wild beasts;

23 for wild beasts will be at peace with you.

24 Then you will know that your house will be at peace, and the dwelling of your tent will certainly not fail.

25 And you will know that your seed is much, and your children will be like all the vegetation of the field.

26 And you will come into a tomb like ripe grain harvested in season or like a heap of a threshing floor gathered in at its time.

27 Behold, these things we traced out thus, these are what we have heard; but know for yourself whether you did anything.

Chapter 6

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 For if someone weighing would weigh my anger, and lift my pains in a balance together,

3 it will indeed be heavier than sand of the seashore; but as it seems, my utterances are worthless.

4 For the Lord's arrows are in my body, whose fury drinks up my blood; whenever I begin to speak, they prick me.

5 For what? Will a wild donkey cry out for nothing, except seeking foods? And will an ox burst into sound at a manger, having its foods?

6 Will bread be eaten without salt? And is there taste in empty utterances?

7 For my soul cannot cease; for I see my foods as a stench, like a lion's smell.

8 For if he would grant it, and my request would come, and the Lord would grant my hope.

9 Having begun, let the Lord wound me, but let him not destroy me utterly.

10 And may my city be a tomb, upon whose walls I leaped; I will certainly not spare it; for I did not falsify my God's holy utterances.

11 For what is my strength, that I endure? Or what is my time, that my soul holds out?

12 Is my strength the strength of stones? Or is my flesh bronze?

13 Had I not trusted in him? But help is absent from me.

14 Mercy disowned me, and the Lord's visitation overlooked me.

15 Those nearest me did not look upon me; like a failing torrent or like a wave they passed me by;

16 those who respected me now have fallen upon me like snow or frozen ice;

17 as, having melted when heat came, it was not recognized as what it was,

18 so I too was abandoned by all, and I perished and became homeless.

19 See the ways of the Thaimans, the paths of the Sabans, you who discern;

20 and those trusting in cities and possessions will owe shame.

21 And moreover you too came upon me mercilessly, so that, seeing my wound, you feared.

22 For what? Did I ask you for anything, or do I need the strength from you

23 to save me from enemies or deliver me from rulers' hands?

24 Teach me, and I will be silent; if I have erred in anything, tell me.

25 But as it seems, a true person's utterances are worthless, for I do not ask strength from you;

26 nor will your reproof stop me with utterances, for neither will I bear a sound of an utterance from you.

27 Only that you fall upon an orphan, and leap upon your friend.

28 But now, looking into your faces, I will not lie.

29 Sit now, and let there be nothing unjust, and again come together with the righteous person.

30 For there is nothing unjust in my tongue; or does my throat not practice understanding?

Chapter 7

1 Is not a human's life upon the earth a trial, and his life like that of a day laborer?

2 Or like an attendant fearing his master and obtaining shade, or like a hired worker awaiting his wages.

3 Thus I too endured empty months, and nights of pains have been given to me.

4 If I lie down, I say, When is day? And whenever I rise, again, When is evening? And I become full of pains from evening until morning.

5 And my body is befouled in the putrefaction of worms, and I dissolve clods of earth, scraping them from the discharge.

6 And my life is lighter than speech, and has perished in empty hope.

7 Remember therefore that my life is breath, and my eye will no longer return to see good.

8 An eye of one seeing me will not look upon me; your eyes are upon me, and I am no longer,

9 like a cloud cleared away from heaven. For if a human descends into Hades, he will certainly not ascend any longer,

10 nor will he certainly return again to his own house, nor will his place recognize him any longer.

11 Therefore neither will I spare my mouth; I will speak, being in necessity, I will open the bitterness of my soul, being constrained.

12 Am I a sea or a dragon, that you assigned a guard over me?

13 I said that my bed will comfort me, and I will bring up a word privately to myself on my couch;

14 you terrify me with dreams and appall me with visions.

15 You will release my soul from my spirit, and my bones from death.

16 For I will not live forever to be long-tempered; depart from me, for my life is empty.

17 For what is a human, that you magnified him, or that you attend your mind to him

18 or make a visitation of him until morning, and judge him for rest?

19 Until when do you not leave me, nor release me until I swallow my saliva in pain?

20 If I sinned, what can I do to you, you who know humans' mind? Why did you set me as your opponent, and I am a burden upon you?

21 And why did you not make a forgetting of my lawlessness and a cleansing of my sin? But now I will go away into earth, and when you rise early, I am no longer.

Chapter 8

1 And taking it up, Baldad the Sauchite says,

2 Until when will you speak these things? The breath of your mouth is wordy.

3 Will the Lord act unjustly when judging, or will the one who made everything disturb what is just?

4 If your sons sinned before him, he sent them away into the hand of their lawlessness.

5 But rise early toward the Lord Almighty, beseeching.

6 If you are clean and true, he will listen to your petition, and restore for you a dwelling of righteousness;

7 therefore your first things will be few, but your last things untold.

8 For ask a former generation, and trace out according to fathers' lineage;

9 for we are of yesterday and do not know, for our life upon the earth is a shadow.

10 Will these not teach you and report and bring forth utterances from a heart?

11 Does papyrus flourish without water, or will a rush grow high without drink?

12 While still upon a root and certainly not harvested, before drinking, does not all vegetation dry up?

13 Thus therefore will be the last things of all those forgetting the Lord; for an ungodly person's hope will perish.

14 For his house will be uninhabited, and his tent will turn out to be a spider's web.

15 If he props up his house, it will certainly not stand; and when he takes hold, it will certainly not endure;

16 for he is moist under the sun, and from his rottenness his shoot will come out.

17 He lies upon a gathering of stones, and will live in the midst of pebbles.

18 If it swallows, the place will deny him; you have not seen such things.

19 Because such is an ungodly person's overthrow, and from earth he will cause another to sprout.

20 For the Lord will certainly not reject the innocent person, but he will not receive any gift of an ungodly person.

21 And he will fill true people's mouth with laughter, and their lips with confession;

22 but their enemies will clothe themselves with shame, and an ungodly person's dwelling will not exist.

Chapter 9

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 In truth I know that it is thus; for how will a mortal be righteous before the Lord?

3 For if he wishes to contend in judgment with him, he will certainly not listen to him, so that he may not contradict one word of his out of a thousand.

4 For he is wise in thought, both mighty and great; who, becoming hard before him, endured?

5 The one making mountains old, and they do not know, the one overturning them in anger;

6 the one shaking what is under heaven from foundations, and its pillars are shaken;

7 the one speaking to the sun, and it does not rise, and he seals up the stars;

8 the one stretching heaven alone and walking upon sea as upon ground;

9 the one making the Pleiad and the Evening Star and Arcturus and chambers of the south;

10 the one doing great and untraceable things, glorious and extraordinary things which have no number.

11 If he passes over me, I will certainly not see; and if he passes me by, neither thus did I know.

12 If he takes away, who will turn him back? Or who will say to him, What did you do?

13 For he himself has turned away anger; by him the sea creatures under heaven were bent.

14 And if he listens to me, surely he will distinguish my utterances.

15 For even if I am righteous, he will not listen to me; I will beseech his judgment;

16 and if I call and he listens, I do not believe that he has heard me.

17 Will he crush me with gloom? And he has made my fractures many for nothing.

18 For he does not allow me to breathe, and filled me with bitterness.

19 For indeed he prevails in strength; who therefore will resist his judgment?

20 For if I am righteous, my mouth will act ungodly; and if I am blameless, I will turn out crooked.

21 For whether I acted ungodly, I do not know in my soul, except that my life is taken away.

22 Therefore I said, Anger destroys a great man and a ruler,

23 because worthless people are in an extraordinary death, but righteous people are laughed at;

24 for they have been handed into an ungodly person's hands. He covers the faces of its judges; but if not he, who is it?

25 And my life is lighter than a runner; they ran away and did not see.

26 And is there a track of a way for ships, or for an eagle flying, seeking food?

27 For if I speak, I will forget while speaking; bending down in face, I will groan.

28 I am shaken in all my limbs, for I know that you will not leave me innocent.

29 And since I am ungodly, why did I not die?

30 For if I wash myself with snow and purify myself with clean hands,

31 you dipped me sufficiently in filth, and my robe abhorred me.

32 For you are not a human like me with whom I will contend in judgment, so that we may come with one accord into judgment.

33 Would that there were our mediator, both reproving and hearing between both;

34 let him remove the rod from me, and let his fear not whirl me about,

35 and I will certainly not fear, but will speak; for I am not conscious thus.

Chapter 10

1 Weary in my soul, groaning, I will release my utterances upon him; I will speak, constrained by bitterness of my soul,

2 and say to the Lord, Do not teach me to act ungodly; and why did you judge me thus?

3 Is it good for you if I act unjustly, that I disown works of your hands, but you attended to ungodly people's counsel?

4 Do you look as a mortal sees, or will you look as a human sees?

5 Is your life human, or your years a man's?

6 Because you sought out my lawlessness and traced out my sins.

7 For you know that I did not act ungodly; but who is the one rescuing from your hands?

8 Your hands fashioned me and made me; after these things, changing, you struck me.

9 Remember that you fashioned me as clay, and you turn me back into earth again.

10 Did you not milk me like milk, and curdle me like cheese?

11 You clothed me in skin and flesh, and threaded me with bones and sinews.

12 And you placed life and mercy with me, and your visitation guarded my spirit.

13 Having these things in yourself, I know that you can do everything, and nothing is impossible for you.

14 For if I sin, you guard me, and you have not made me innocent from lawlessness.

15 For if I am ungodly, woe to me; and if I am righteous, I cannot lift my head, for I am full of dishonor.

16 For I am hunted like a lion for slaughter, and changing again you terribly destroy me,

17 renewing my examination against me; and you treated me with great anger, and brought trials upon me.

18 Why therefore did you bring me out from a belly, and I did not die, and an eye did not see me,

19 and I became as though not existing? For why was I not carried from womb to tomb?

20 Is not the time of my life little? Allow me to rest a little

21 before I go where I will not return, into a dark and gloomy land,

22 into a land of everlasting darkness, where there is no brightness nor seeing of mortals' life.

Chapter 11

1 And taking it up, Sophar the Minaite says,

2 The one saying many things will also hear in reply; or does the fluent speaker also think he is righteous? Blessed is one born of a woman, short-lived.

3 Do not become abundant in utterances, for there is no one contending in judgment with you.

4 For do not say, I am clean in works and blameless before him.

5 But how might the Lord speak to you? And he will open his lips with you.

6 Then he will report to you the power of wisdom, because he will be double the things with you; and then you will know that things worthy of what you have sinned befell you from the Lord.

7 Will you find a track of the Lord, or did you reach the last things which the Almighty made?

8 Heaven is high, and what will you do? And what do you know deeper than the things in Hades?

9 Or longer than the measure of earth or the breadth of sea?

10 And if he overturns everything, who will say to him, What did you do?

11 For he himself knows lawless people's works, and seeing improper things he will not overlook them.

12 But a human vainly swims in words, and a mortal born of a woman is like a wilderness donkey.

13 For if you made your heart clean, and turn your hands upward toward him,

14 if anything lawless is in your hands, make it far from you, and let injustice not lodge in your dwelling.

15 For thus your face will shine like clean water, and you will put off filth and certainly not fear;

16 and you will forget weariness like a wave that passed, and will not be frightened;

17 and your prayer is like the morning star, and from midday life will rise for you;

18 and you will be confident because you have hope, and from anxiety and concern peace will appear for you.

19 For you will be quiet, and there will be no one warring against you; and many, having changed, will beseech you.

20 But salvation will abandon them; for their hope is destruction, and ungodly people's eyes will melt.

Chapter 12

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 Then you are humans; surely wisdom will die with you.

3 Indeed I too have a heart like you.

4 For a righteous and blameless man became a mockery;

5 for at an appointed time he had been prepared to fall under others, and his houses to be ravaged by lawless people.

6 Nevertheless let no one, being evil, trust that he will be innocent, as many as provoke the Lord, as though there will not also be an examination of them.

7 But now ask quadrupeds if they may tell you, and birds of heaven if they may report to you;

8 and relate to earth if it may tell you, and the fish of the sea will explain to you.

9 Who did not know among all these things that the Lord's hand did these things?

10 Is not the soul of all the living and the spirit of every human in his hand?

11 For an ear distinguishes utterances, and a throat tastes foods.

12 In much time is wisdom, and in much life understanding.

13 With him are wisdom and power, to him belong counsel and understanding.

14 If he casts down, who will build? If he closes against humans, who will open?

15 If he restrains the water, he will dry the earth; but if he releases it, he destroyed it, overturning it.

16 With him are dominion and strength, to him belong knowledge and understanding.

17 Leading counselors captive, and he confounded judges of earth.

18 Seating kings upon thrones, and he bound their loins with a belt.

19 Sending priests away captive, and he overturned rulers of earth.

20 Changing faithful people's lips, and he knew elders' understanding.

21 Pouring dishonor upon rulers, and he healed lowly people.

22 Uncovering deep things from darkness, and he brought a shadow of death into light.

23 Leading nations astray and destroying them, laying nations low and guiding them.

24 Changing the hearts of rulers of earth, and he led them astray on a way which they did not know;

25 may they grope in darkness and not light, and may they be led astray like the drunkard.

Chapter 13

1 Behold, my eye has seen these things and my ear has heard;

2 and I know as much as you also know, and I am not less understanding than you.

3 Nevertheless I will speak to the Lord, and I will argue before him if he wishes.

4 But you are unjust physicians and all healers of evils.

5 May you be silent, and it will turn out as wisdom for you.

6 Hear the argument of my mouth, and attend to the judgment of my lips.

7 Do you not speak before the Lord, and utter deceit before him?

8 Will you shrink back? But become judges yourselves.

9 It is indeed good if he traces you out; for if, doing everything, you will be added to him,

10 he will reprove you no less; and if you also secretly admire faces,

11 will not his terrors whirl you about, and fear from him fall upon you?

12 And your exultation will turn out like ashes, and the body clay.

13 Be silent, so that I may speak and rest from wrath,

14 taking up my flesh with my teeth, and I will put my soul in my hand.

15 If the ruler subdues me, since he has also begun, surely I will speak and argue before him;

16 and this will turn out as salvation for me, for deceit will not enter before him.

17 Hear, hear my utterances; for I will report while you hear.

18 Behold, I am near my judgment, I know that I will appear righteous.

19 For who is the one who will contend in judgment with me? Because now I will be silent and fail.

20 And you will grant me two things; then I will not hide from your face;

21 keep your hand away from me, and let your fear not appall me.

22 Then you will call and I will listen to you; or you will speak and I will give you an answer.

23 How many are my sins and my lawless deeds? Teach me what they are.

24 Why do you hide from me, and regard me as opposed to you?

25 Will you be wary as of a leaf moved by wind, or are you opposed to me as to grass carried by a breeze?

26 Because you wrote evil things against me, and put sins of youth around me,

27 and put my foot in a restraint, and guarded all my works, and reached the roots of my feet;

28 which grows old like a wineskin or like a moth-eaten garment.

Chapter 14

1 For a mortal born of a woman is short-lived and full of anger,

2 or like a flower that blossomed he fell away, and fled like a shadow and will certainly not stand.

3 Did you not also take account of this one and make him enter into judgment before you?

4 For who will be clean from filth? But no one.

5 Even if his life upon the earth is one day, and his months are numbered with you, you set a time, and he will certainly not exceed it.

6 Depart from him, so that he may be quiet and be pleased with life like the hired worker.

7 For a tree has hope; for if it is cut down, it will blossom again, and its shoot will certainly not fail;

8 for if its root grows old in earth and its stem dies in rock,

9 from the fragrance of water it will blossom, and make a harvest like a newly planted tree.

10 But a man, having died, went away, and a mortal, having fallen, is no longer.

11 For in time a sea dwindles, and a river, having become desolate, dried up;

12 but a human, having lain down, will certainly not rise until heaven is no longer stitched together; and they will not be awakened from their sleep.

13 For would that you guarded me in Hades, and hid me until your anger ceases, and appoint me a time in which you may make remembrance of me.

14 For if a human dies, he will live, having completed days of his life; I will endure until I come to be again.

15 Then you will call and I will listen to you, and do not reject the works of your hands.

16 And you numbered my practices, and none of my sins will certainly pass you by;

17 and you sealed my lawless deeds in a purse, and marked whether I transgressed anything unwillingly.

18 And yet a falling mountain will fall apart, and a rock will be worn away from its place;

19 waters smoothed stones, and waters flooded the flat places of the earth's mound; and you destroyed a human's endurance.

20 You thrust him utterly, and he went away; you set your face upon him and sent him away;

21 and when his sons become many, he does not know, and if they become few, he does not understand;

22 except his flesh suffered, and his soul mourned.

Chapter 15

1 And taking it up, Eliphas the Thaimanite says,

2 Will a wise person give an answer of understanding of spirit, and filled trouble of a belly,

3 arguing with utterances with which one ought not, with words in which there is no benefit?

4 Did you not also reject fear, and complete such utterances before the Lord?

5 You are guilty by your mouth's utterances, nor did you distinguish rulers' utterances;

6 may your own mouth reprove you and not I, and your lips will testify against you.

7 For what? Did you become the first of humans? Or were you fixed before dunes?

8 Have you heard the Lord's ordinance, and did wisdom reach you?

9 For what do you know that we do not know? Or what do you understand that we do not also?

10 Indeed both an elder and an ancient one are among us, weightier in days than your father.

11 You have been whipped little for what you have sinned; you have spoken greatly beyond measure.

12 What did your heart dare, or what did your eyes bring on,

13 that you burst into wrath before the Lord, and brought such utterances out from your mouth?

14 For who is a mortal that he will be blameless, or how will one born of a woman be righteous?

15 If he does not trust holy ones, and heaven is not clean before him.

16 But leave aside one abhorred and unclean, a man drinking injustices like a drink.

17 And I will report to you; hear me; what indeed I have seen I will report to you,

18 what wise people will say, and they did not hide their fathers;

19 to them alone the earth was given, and no foreigner came upon them.

20 An ungodly person's whole life is in concern, and numbered years given to a ruler,

21 and his fear in his ears; whenever he thinks he is already at peace, his overthrow will come.

22 Let him not trust that he will turn back from darkness; for he has already been appointed into the hands of iron,

23 and has been assigned as food for vultures; and he knows in himself that he remains for a fall. And a dark day will whirl him about,

24 and necessity and affliction will hold him like a general falling in the front rank.

25 Because he has raised hands before the Lord, and acted stiff-necked before the Lord Almighty,

26 and ran against him with arrogance in the thickness of the back of his shield,

27 because he covered his face in his fat and made a covering upon his thighs.

28 And may he lodge in deserted cities, and enter uninhabited houses; and what those people prepared, others will carry away.

29 Neither will he certainly be made rich, nor will his possessions certainly remain; he will certainly not cast a shadow upon the earth,

30 nor will he escape darkness; may wind wither his shoot, and may his flower fall away.

31 Let him not trust that he will endure, for empty things will turn out for him;

32 his cutting will be destroyed before its time, and his shoot will certainly not grow thick;

33 and may he be harvested like an unripe grape before its time, and fall away like an olive's flower.

34 For an ungodly person's testimony is death, and fire will burn bribe-takers' houses.

35 And in the womb he will conceive pains, and empty things will turn out for him, and his belly will bear deceit.

Chapter 16

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 I have heard many such things; all are comforters of evils.

3 For what? Is there an order to utterances of wind? Or what will trouble you, that you answer?

4 I too will speak like you, if indeed your soul were in place of mine; then I will leap upon you with utterances, and shake my head against you;

5 and may there be strength in my mouth, and I will not spare movement of lips.

6 For if I speak, I will not suffer the wound; and if I also keep silent, how much less will I be wounded?

7 But now he has made me exhausted, foolish, rotten,

8 and you seized me; it became a testimony; and my falsehood rose within me, it answered against my face.

9 Having used anger, he cast me down, he gnashed his teeth against me, arrows of his raiders fell upon me.

10 With points of eyes he leaped upon me, with a sharp thing he struck me on the cheek, and with one accord they rushed upon me.

11 For the Lord handed me into an unjust person's hands, and cast me upon ungodly people;

12 while I was at peace he scattered me, taking me by the hair he tore it out, he set me like a target.

13 They encircled me with spears, throwing at my kidneys, not sparing, they poured my gall upon the earth;

14 they cast me down, fall upon fall, they ran toward me, being powerful.

15 I sewed sackcloth upon my hide, and my might was extinguished in earth.

16 My belly has been burned from weeping, and upon my eyelids is a shadow.

17 And nothing unjust was in my hands, and my prayer is clean.

18 Earth, do not cover over the blood of my flesh, nor let there be a place for my cry.

19 And now behold, my witness is in heavens, and the one knowing with me in the highest places.

20 May my petition reach the Lord, and may my eye drip before him.

21 And may there be an argument for a man before the Lord, and a son of a human for his neighbor.

22 And numbered years have come, and I will go on a way on which I will not return.

Chapter 17

1 I perish, carried by a wind, and need burial and do not obtain it.

2 I implore, being weary, and having done what?

3 And strangers stole my possessions. Who is this one? Let him be bound to my hand.

4 Because you hid their heart from prudence, therefore you will certainly not exalt them.

5 He will report evils to the portion, and my eyes melted over sons.

6 And you made me a byword among nations, and I turned out a laughingstock for them;

7 for my eyes have been hardened from anger, I have been greatly besieged by all.

8 Amazement held true people at this; and may a righteous person rise against a lawless person;

9 and may a faithful person hold his own way, and one clean in hands take up confidence.

10 Nevertheless all of you press on, and come now; for I find no truth among you.

11 My days passed in a stench, and the joints of my heart were torn.

12 They made night into day, light near from the face of darkness.

13 For if I endure, Hades is my house, and in gloom my bedding has been spread.

14 I called upon death to be my father, and rottenness my mother and sister.

15 Where therefore is my hope any longer? Will I see my good things?

16 Will they descend with me into Hades, or will we descend with one accord upon a mound?

Chapter 18

1 And taking it up, Baldad the Sauchite says,

2 Until when will you not cease? Hold back, so that we ourselves also may speak.

3 Why have we been silent like quadrupeds before you?

4 Anger has treated you. For what? If you die, is what is under heaven uninhabited? Or will mountains be overturned from foundations?

5 And ungodly people's light will be extinguished, and their flame will not come forth;

6 his light is darkness in a dwelling, and the lamp over him will be extinguished.

7 May the least people hunt his possessions, and may his counsel trip him.

8 And his foot has been cast into a trap; may he be entangled in a net.

9 And may traps come upon him; it will make thirsty ones prevail against him.

10 His cord has been hidden in the earth, and his capture upon paths.

11 May pains destroy him round about, and may many come around his feet in severe famine.

12 And an extraordinary fall has been prepared for him.

13 May the branches of his feet be devoured, and death will devour his beautiful things.

14 And may healing be torn out from his dwelling, and may necessity hold him by a royal charge.

15 It will dwell in his tent in his night, his comely things will be strewn with sulfur.

16 Below, his roots will be dried, and above, his harvest will fall down.

17 May his memorial perish from earth, and a name belongs to him upon the face outside.

18 May he thrust him from light into darkness.

19 He will not be known among his people, nor his house saved in what is under heaven, but others will live in his things.

20 The last groaned over him, and amazement held the first.

21 These are unjust people's houses, and this the place of those not knowing the Lord.

Chapter 19

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 Until when will you make my soul weary and pull me down with words?

3 Know only that the Lord made me thus; you speak against me, not respecting me you press upon me.

4 Yes indeed, in truth I erred, and error lodges with me,

4 a to speak an utterance which one ought not, and my utterances wander and are not in season.

5 But leave aside that you magnify yourselves over me, and leap upon me with reproach.

6 Know therefore that it is the Lord who disturbed me, and he raised his stronghold against me.

7 Behold, I laugh at reproach and will not speak; I will cry out, and judgment is nowhere.

8 I have been built around on all sides and will certainly not pass through, he set darkness before my face.

9 And he stripped glory from me, and took a crown away from my head.

10 He tore me apart round about, and I went away; and he cut out my hope like a tree.

11 And he treated me terribly with anger, and regarded me like an enemy.

12 And his trials came with one accord upon me on my ways, ambushers encircled me.

13 And my brothers departed from me, they knew strangers rather than me; and my friends have become merciless.

14 Those nearest me did not acknowledge me, and those knowing my name forgot me.

15 Neighbors of the house and my maidservants, I was a foreigner before them.

16 I called my attendant, and he did not listen; and my mouth was beseeching.

17 And I implored my wife, and called upon sons of my concubines, flattering;

18 but they rejected me forever; whenever I rise, they speak against me.

19 And those knowing me abhorred me; those whom I had loved rose against me.

20 My flesh rotted in my skin, and my bones are held in teeth.

21 Have mercy on me, have mercy on me, friends; for it is the Lord's hand that touched me.

22 And why do you pursue me like the Lord also, and are not filled from my flesh?

23 For who might grant that my utterances be written, and set in a book forever,

24 with an iron stylus and lead, or engraved in rocks?

25 For I know that the one about to release me upon earth is everlasting.

26 May he raise my skin which endures these things; for these things were accomplished for me by the Lord,

27 which I know with myself, which my eye has seen and not another; and everything has been accomplished for me in my bosom.

28 And if you also will say, What will we say before him? And we will find a root of a word in him;

29 be wary now, you too, of a covering; for wrath will come upon lawless people, and then they will know where their material is.

Chapter 20

1 And taking it up, Sophar the Minaite says,

2 I did not suppose you would contradict these things thus, and you do not understand more than I also.

3 I will hear discipline of my shame, and a spirit from understanding answers me.

4 Did you not know these things from of old, from when a human was set upon the earth?

5 For ungodly people's gladness is an extraordinary fall, and lawless people's joy destruction,

6 if his gifts ascend into heaven and his sacrifice touches clouds.

7 For whenever he thinks he has already been established, then he will perish utterly; and those seeing him will say, Where is he?

8 Like a dream flown away he will certainly not be found, and he flew like a nocturnal apparition.

9 An eye looked upon him and will not do so again, and his place will no longer perceive him.

10 May inferior people destroy his sons, and may his hands kindle pains.

11 His bones were filled with his youth, and it will lie with him upon a mound.

12 If wickedness is sweetened in his mouth, he will hide it under his tongue;

13 he will not spare it and will not abandon it and will hold it in the midst of his throat.

14 And he will certainly not be able to help himself; an asp's gall is in his belly.

15 Wealth gathered unjustly will be vomited out; an angel will draw it out from his house.

16 And may he suck dragons' fury, and may a snake's tongue kill him.

17 May he not see milking of grazing herds, nor pastures of honey and butter.

18 For empty and vain things he labored for wealth, from which he will not taste, like something astringent, unchewable, unswallowable.

19 For he crushed many powerless people's houses, and seized a dwelling and did not establish it.

20 There is no salvation for him in possessions, in his desire he will not be saved.

21 There is no remnant of his foods; therefore his good things will not blossom.

22 And whenever he thinks he has already been filled, he will be afflicted, and every necessity will come upon him.

23 If somehow he might fill his belly, may he send upon him a fury of anger, may he rain pains upon him;

24 and he will certainly not be saved from the hand of iron, may a bronze bow wound him;

25 and may an arrow pass through his body, and may lightnings walk in his dwellings; fears are upon him.

26 And may all darkness remain for him; an unkindled fire will devour him, and may a stranger harm his house.

27 And may heaven uncover his lawless deeds, and earth rise against him.

28 May destruction drag his house utterly away, may a day of anger come upon him.

29 This is the portion of an ungodly human from the Lord, and the estate of possessions belonging to him from the overseer.

Chapter 21

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 Hear, hear my words, so that this comfort from you may not be mine.

3 Bear me, and I will speak, then you will not laugh at me.

4 For what? Is my argument against a human? Or why will I not be wrathful?

5 Look at me and marvel, putting a hand upon a cheek.

6 For if I remember, I am agitated, and pains hold my flesh.

7 Why do ungodly people live, and have grown old even in wealth?

8 Their seed is according to their soul, and their children before their eyes.

9 Their houses flourish, and fear is nowhere, and there is no scourge from the Lord upon them.

10 Their cow did not give birth prematurely, and their pregnant one was preserved and did not miscarry.

11 And they remain like everlasting sheep, and their children play,

12 taking up a psaltery and lyre, and they are gladdened by a sound of a psalm.

13 And they completed their life amid good things, and slept in the rest of Hades.

14 And he says to the Lord, Depart from me, I do not wish to know your ways;

15 what is the Sufficient One, that we will serve him? And what benefit, that we will meet him?

16 For their good things were in their hands, and he does not look upon ungodly people's works.

17 Nevertheless ungodly people's lamp also will be extinguished, and their overthrow will come upon them, and birth pangs will hold them from anger.

18 And they will be like chaff before wind, or like dust which a tempest took away.

19 May his possessions abandon sons; he will repay him and he will know.

20 May his eyes see his own slaughter, and may he not be preserved from the Lord;

21 because what pleasure has he in his house after him? And the numbers of his months were divided.

22 Is it not the Lord who teaches understanding and knowledge? And he himself will distinguish murders.

23 This one will die in the dominion of his simplicity, and wholly enjoying himself and flourishing;

24 and his inward parts full of fat, and his marrow is poured out.

25 But that one dies through bitterness of soul, having eaten nothing good.

26 And with one accord they lie upon earth, and rottenness covered them.

27 So I know you, that you press upon me with daring;

28 because you will say, Where is a ruler's house? And where is the shelter of ungodly people's tents?

29 Ask those passing along a way, and you will not disown their signs;

30 because the evil person is spared for a day of destruction, they will be led away for a day of his anger.

31 Who will report his way to his face? And he himself did it, who will repay him?

32 And he himself was carried into tombs and kept vigil upon a coffin.

33 Pebbles of a torrent were sweetened for him, and after him every human will go away, and before him innumerable ones.

34 And how do you comfort me with empty things? And my ceasing from you is nothing.

Chapter 22

1 And taking it up, Eliphas the Thaimanite says,

2 Is it not the Lord who teaches understanding and knowledge?

3 For what does the Lord care if you were blameless in works? Or what benefit, that you make your way simple?

4 Will he, taking account of you, reprove you and enter into judgment together with you?

5 Is not your wickedness much, and are not your sins innumerable?

6 And you took pledges from your brothers for nothing, and took away naked people's clothing;

7 nor did you give thirsty people water to drink, but deprived hungry people of a morsel;

8 and you admired certain people's face, and settled those upon the earth;

9 and you sent widows away empty, and harmed orphans.

10 Therefore traps encircled you, and an extraordinary war agitated you;

11 light turned into darkness for you, and water covered you as you lay down.

12 Does not the one dwelling in the heights look upon things, and he humbled those carried by arrogance?

13 And you said, What did the Strong One know? Will he judge through gloom?

14 Clouds are his hiding place, and he will not be seen, and he will pass through the circle of heaven.

15 Will you keep an everlasting path which unjust men trod,

16 who were seized before their time? Their foundations are a flowing river,

17 those saying, What will the Lord do to us? Or what will the Almighty bring upon us?

18 But he filled their houses with good things, and ungodly people's counsel is far from him.

19 Righteous people saw and laughed, and a blameless person sneered.

20 Unless their substance vanished, and fire will devour their remnant.

21 Become firm now, if you endure; then your fruit will be amid good things.

22 And receive a declaration from his mouth and take up his utterances in your heart.

23 And if you turn and humble yourself before the Lord, you made injustice far from your dwelling.

24 You will place upon a mound in rock, and like rock torrents of Ophir.

25 Therefore the Almighty will be your helper against enemies, and will render you clean like silver tried by fire.

26 Then you will speak frankly before the Lord, looking up into heaven cheerfully;

27 and when you pray to him, he will listen to you, and grant you to repay the vows;

28 and he will restore for you a dwelling of righteousness, and upon your ways there will be brightness.

29 Because he humbled him, and you will say, He acted proudly, and he will save one downcast in eyes;

30 he will deliver an innocent person, and be preserved through your clean hands.

Chapter 23

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 And indeed I know that the argument is out of my hand, and his hand has become heavy upon my groaning.

3 And who therefore might know that I would find him and come to the end?

4 And may I speak my own judgment, and fill my mouth with arguments;

5 and may I know utterances which he will say to me, and perceive what he will report to me.

6 And if he will come upon me with much strength, then he will not treat me with a threat;

7 for truth and argument are from him, and may he bring my judgment out to the end.

8 For I will go to the first things and am no longer; and what do I know of the last things?

9 When he worked on the left, I did not grasp him; he will cover the right, and I will not see.

10 For he already knows my way, and he tested me like gold.

11 And I will go out in his commandments; for I kept his ways and will certainly not turn aside

12 from his commandments, and I will certainly not pass beyond, and in my bosom I hid his utterances.

13 And if he himself also judged thus, who is the one who contradicted him? For what he himself wished, he also did.

15 Therefore I am agitated at him; and being admonished, I was concerned about him.

15 a At this may I be agitated before his face; I will consider and be frightened by him.

16 And the Lord softened my heart, and the Almighty agitated me.

17 For I did not know that darkness would come upon me, and gloom covered before my face.

Chapter 24

1 And why did hours escape the Lord's notice,

2 and ungodly people crossed a boundary, seizing a flock with a shepherd?

3 They led away orphans' beast of burden, and took a widow's ox as a pledge.

4 They turned powerless people aside from a righteous way, the meek of earth hid with one accord.

5 And they went out like donkeys in a field, going forth upon their own business beyond me; bread was sweetened for him for younger ones.

6 They harvested a field not theirs before its time; and powerless people worked ungodly people's vineyards without wages and without food.

7 They made many naked people lie down without garments, and took away the clothing of their soul.

8 They are wet from drops of mountains; through not having shelter they embraced a rock.

9 They seized an orphan from a breast, and humbled a fallen person.

10 And they unjustly made naked people lie down, and took a morsel away from hungry people.

11 In narrow places they unjustly ambushed, and did not know a righteous way.

12 Those who were being cast out from a city and their own houses, and infants' soul groaned greatly, but why has he himself not made a visitation of these things?

13 While they were upon earth, they did not recognize, and did not know a way of righteousness, nor walk its paths.

14 And knowing their works, he handed them over into darkness, and at night he will be like a thief.

15 And an adulterer's eye watched for darkness, saying, An eye will not perceive me, and he made a hiding of his face.

16 He dug through houses in darkness; by day they sealed themselves, they did not recognize light;

17 because with one accord the morning is a shadow of death for them, because he will recognize disturbances of a shadow of death.

18 He is light upon the face of water; may their portion upon earth be cursed.

19 And may their plants upon earth appear dry; for they seized orphans' armful.

20 Then his sin was remembered, and like a mist of dew he became invisible; and may what he did be repaid to him, and may every unjust person be shattered like incurable wood.

21 For he did not treat a barren woman well and did not show mercy to a woman,

22 and with wrath he overturned powerless people. Therefore when he rises, he will certainly not trust in his own life;

23 having become weak, let him not hope to be made healthy, but he will fall by sickness.

24 For his elevation harmed many; and he withered like mallow in heat or like an ear of grain falling by itself from a stalk.

25 But if not, who is the one saying I speak falsely and will make my utterances nothing?

Chapter 25

1 And taking it up, Baldad the Sauchite says,

2 For what prelude or fear is from him, the one making the whole in the highest place?

3 For might anyone suppose there is delay for raiders? And upon whom will an ambush from him not come?

4 For how will a mortal be righteous before the Lord? Or who born of a woman might purify himself?

5 If he commands the moon, and it does not shine; and stars are not clean before him.

6 But leave aside a human, rottenness, and a son of a human, a worm.

Chapter 26

1 And taking it up, Iob says,

2 To whom do you attach yourself, or whom are you about to help? Is it not one whose strength is much and whose arm is mighty?

3 Whom have you advised? Is it not one who has all wisdom? Or whom will you follow? Is it not one who has greatest power?

4 To whom did you report utterances? And whose breath is that which came out from you?

5 Will giants be brought to birth beneath water and its neighbors?

6 Hades is naked before him, and destruction has no covering.

7 Stretching north upon nothing, hanging earth upon nothing;

8 binding water in his clouds, and a cloud was not torn beneath it;

9 the one holding the face of a throne, spreading his cloud upon it.

10 He circled a command upon the face of water until the completion of light with darkness.

11 Heaven's pillars spread out and were confounded by his rebuke.

12 With strength he quieted the sea, and with knowledge wounded the sea creature;

13 and heaven's bolts fear him, and by command he put an apostate dragon to death.

14 Behold, these are parts of his way, and we will hear but a drop of a word in him; and who knows the might of his thunder whenever he will do it?

Chapter 27

1 And Iob, adding still, said in the prelude,

2 The Lord lives, who has judged me thus, and the Almighty who embittered my soul,

3 surely while my breath is still within, and a divine spirit remaining in my nostrils,

4 my lips will not speak lawless things, nor will my soul practice unjust things.

5 May it not be mine to declare you righteous until I die; for I will not put away my innocence.

6 And holding fast to righteousness, I will certainly not let it go; for I am not conscious of having done improper things.

7 Nevertheless may my enemies be like ungodly people's overthrow, and those rising against me like lawless people's destruction.

8 For what hope has an ungodly person that he holds on? Trusting in the Lord, will he indeed be saved?

9 Will the Lord listen to his petition? Or when necessity comes upon him,

10 does he have any frankness before him? Or when he calls upon him, will he listen to him?

11 But now I will report to you what is in the Lord's hand; what is with the Almighty, I will not falsify.

12 Behold now, you all know that you heap empty things upon empty things.

13 This is an ungodly human's portion from the Lord, and rulers' estate will come upon them from the Almighty.

14 And if his sons become many, they will be for slaughter; and if they also become men, they will beg;

15 and his survivors will die in death, and no one will show mercy to their widows.

16 If he gathers silver like earth, and prepares gold like clay,

17 righteous people will acquire all these things, and true people will hold his possessions.

18 And his house turned out like moths and like a spider's web.

19 A rich person lay down and will not do so again; he opened his eyes and is not.

20 Pains met him like water, and at night gloom took him away;

21 a burning wind will take him up and he will go away, and it will winnow him from his place.

22 And it will cast upon him and will not spare; from its hand he will flee in flight;

23 it will clap its hands over him and hiss him out of his place.

Chapter 28

1 For silver has a place from which it comes, and gold a place from which it is refined.

2 For iron comes from earth, and copper is quarried like stone.

3 He set an order for darkness, and he himself examines every limit precisely: stone, darkness, and shadow of death,

4 a cutting of a torrent from dust; but those who forget a righteous way became weak among mortals.

5 Earth—from it bread will come forth; beneath it, it was turned as though by fire.

6 Its stones are a place of sapphire, and its mound has gold.

7 A path—a bird has not known it, and a vulture's eye has not looked upon it;

8 sons of arrogant ones have not trodden it; a lion has not passed upon it.

9 He stretched out his hand upon sheer rock, and overturned mountains from their roots;

10 and he broke through the eddies of rivers, and my eye saw every precious thing;

11 and he uncovered the depths of rivers, and showed his own power into light.

12 But from where was wisdom found? And what is the place of knowledge?

13 A mortal does not know its way, nor will it ever be found among humans.

14 13 The abyss said, It is not in me; and the sea said, It is not with me.

15 He will not give a thing shut away for it, and silver will not be weighed as its exchange;

16 and it will not be weighed together with gold of Ophir, with precious onyx and sapphire;

17 gold and glass will not be equaled to it, nor golden vessels as its exchange;

18 lofty things and gabis will not be mentioned, and draw wisdom beyond the innermost things;

19 topaz of Ethiopia will not be equaled to it; with pure gold it will not be weighed together.

20 But from where was wisdom found? And what is the place of understanding?

21 It has escaped every human's notice, and was hidden from the birds of heaven;

22 destruction and death said, But we have heard its fame.

23 God established its way well, and he himself knows its place;

24 for he himself surveys everything beneath heaven, knowing all the things in the earth which he made,

25 the weight of winds and measures of water;

26 when he made thus, he numbered rain and a way for voices in a shaking;

27 then he saw it and explained it; having prepared it, he traced it out.

28 And he said to a human, Behold, reverence for God is wisdom, and abstaining from evils is knowledge.

Chapter 29

1 And Iob, adding yet again, said in his prelude,

2 Who would place me according to a month before the days in which God guarded me?

3 As when his lamp shone above my head, when by his light I walked in darkness;

4 when I was weighty in ways, when God made an inspection of my house;

5 when I was very flourishing, and my children were around me;

6 when my ways flowed with butter, and my mountains flowed with milk;

7 when I went out early in the city, and my seat was set in the squares.

8 Young men, seeing me, hid themselves, and all the old men stood;

9 and the great ceased speaking, placing a finger upon their mouth.

10 And those who heard pronounced me blessed, and their tongue stuck to their throat;

11 because an ear heard and pronounced me blessed, and an eye, seeing me, turned aside.

12 For I rescued a poor man from a ruler's hand, and helped an orphan who had no helper;

13 may a perishing man's blessing come upon me, and a widow's mouth blessed me.

14 And I had put on righteousness, and clothed myself with judgment as with a double cloak.

15 I was an eye of the blind, and a foot of the lame.

16 I was a father of the powerless, and a case which I did not know I traced out;

17 and I crushed the molars of the unjust, and tore plunder from between their teeth.

18 And I said, My age will grow old; like the trunk of a palm I will live a long time;

19 my root has opened out upon water, and dew will lodge in my harvest;

20 my glory is fresh with me, and my bow will go in his hand.

21 Hearing me, they attended, and were silent at my counsel;

22 and they added nothing to my word, and became overjoyed whenever I spoke to them;

23 as thirsty earth awaiting the rain, so these awaited my speech.

24 If I laugh toward them, they will certainly not believe, and the light of my face did not fall away;

25 I chose their way and sat as ruler, and encamped like a king among men wearing a single belt, in the manner of one comforting sufferers.

Chapter 30

1 But now they laughed at me; the least now admonish me in turn, whose fathers I despised, whom I did not consider worthy of the dogs of my flocks.

2 And indeed, the strength of their hands—what is it to me? Completion perished upon them,

3 barren in want and famine; those fleeing a waterless land yesterday, distress and misery,

4 those breaking off saltwort upon a sounding place, whose food was saltwort, dishonored and despised, lacking every good thing, who also chewed roots of trees from great famine.

5 Thieves rose against me,

6 whose houses were holes in rocks;

7 among well-sounding places they will shout; those who lived beneath wild brushwood,

8 sons of senseless and dishonored men, a name and fame extinguished from earth.

9 But now I am their lyre, and they have me as a tale;

10 and they abhorred me, standing far away, and did not spare spittle from my face.

11 For, opening his quiver, he afflicted me, and they sent away the bridle of my face.

12 On the right of a shoot they rose, stretched out their foot, and made ways against me, paths of their destruction.

13 My paths were worn away, for he stripped off my robe;

14 with his missiles he speared me; he has treated me as he wishes; I am drenched in pains.

15 And my pains return; my hope departed like wind, and my salvation like a cloud.

16 And now my soul will be poured out upon me, and days of pains hold me;

17 and by night my bones have been burned together, and my sinews have been loosened.

18 With great strength he seized my robe; like the collar of my tunic he enclosed me.

19 And you have considered me equal to clay; in earth and ashes is my portion;

20 and I have cried to you, and you do not hear me; they stood and observed me;

21 and you assailed me mercilessly; with a mighty hand you scourged me;

22 and you placed me in pains and cast me away from salvation.

23 For I know that death will wear me away; for earth is a house for every mortal.

24 For if only I could subdue myself, or at least ask another, and he will do this for me.

25 But I wept over every powerless person, and groaned on seeing a man in necessities.

26 But I, looking for good things—behold, days of evils met me instead.

27 My belly boiled over and will not be silent; days of poverty came before me.

28 I have walked groaning without a muzzle, and have stood in an assembly crying out.

29 I have become a brother of sirens, and a companion of sparrows.

30 And my skin has become greatly darkened, and my bones from burning heat.

31 And my lyre turned to suffering, and my psalm to weeping for me.

Chapter 31

1 I made a covenant with my eyes, and I will not give attention to a virgin.

2 And what did God apportion from above, and what is the inheritance of the Sufficient One from the highest places?

3 Is it not destruction for the unjust, and estrangement for those doing lawlessness?

4 Will he himself not see my way and count all my steps?

5 But if I had walked with jesters, and if my foot also hastened into deceit,

6 then may he weigh me in a righteous balance; and the Lord knows my innocence.

7 If my foot turned aside from the way, and if my heart also followed my eye, and if with my hands I also touched gifts,

8 then may I sow and others eat, and may I become rootless upon earth.

9 If my heart followed another man's wife, if I also became one lying in wait at her doors,

10 then may my wife also please another, and may my little children be humbled;

11 for defiling a man's wife is an unrestrainable fury of anger;

12 for it is a fire burning upon all parts, and wherever it comes, it destroyed from the roots.

13 And if I also despised the case of my attendant or maidservant when they were in judgment with me,

14 for what will I do if the Lord makes an examination of me? And if also an inspection, what answer will I make?

15 Were they not also brought into being as I was in a womb? And we have been brought into being in the same belly.

16 And the powerless did not fail to obtain a need which they ever had, and I did not waste away a widow's eye.

17 And if I also ate my morsel alone, and did not share with an orphan;

18 because from my youth I reared as a father, and from my mother's womb I guided;

19 and if I also overlooked a naked man perishing, and did not clothe him,

20 and if the powerless did not bless me, and their shoulders were warmed from the shearing of my lambs,

21 if I raised a hand against an orphan, trusting that much help was available to me,

22 then may my shoulder depart from the collarbone, and may my arm be crushed from my elbow.

23 For fear of the Lord held me fast, and before his taking hold I will not endure.

24 If I appointed gold as my strength, and if I also trusted in a costly stone,

25 and if I also rejoiced when much wealth came to me, and if I also placed my hand upon uncountable things,

26 do I not indeed see the shining sun failing, and the moon waning? For it is not in their power.

27 And if my heart was deceived secretly, and if I also placed my hand upon my mouth and kissed it,

28 then may this also be reckoned to me as the greatest lawlessness, because I lied before the Lord Most High.

29 And if I also became joyful at my enemies' fall, and my heart said, Well done,

30 then may my ear hear my curse, and then may I be talked about by my people as one afflicted.

31 And if my maidservants also often said, Who would grant us to be filled with his flesh?—since I was very kind;

32 and a stranger did not lodge outside, and my door stood open to everyone coming.

33 And if, sinning unwillingly, I also hid my sin,

34 for I did not shrink from the multitude's great crowd so as not to declare it before them; and if I also let a powerless man go out my door with an empty bosom,

35 who would grant me someone hearing me? And if I had not feared the Lord's hand, a written bond which I held against someone,

36 placing it upon my shoulders as a crown, I would read it,

37 and if I did not tear it up and return it, taking nothing from a debtor,

38 if the earth ever groaned against me, and if its furrows also wept with one accord,

39 and if I also ate its strength alone without payment, and if I also cast out the soul of the earth's owner and grieved him,

40 then may nettle come forth for me instead of wheat, and bramble instead of barley. And Iob ceased with words.

Chapter 32

1 And his three friends also ceased opposing Iob further; for Iob was righteous before them.

2 And Elious, the son of Barachiel, the Bouzite, of the kindred of Ram, of the land of Ausitis, became angry; and he became exceedingly angry with Iob because he declared himself righteous before the Lord;

3 and against the three friends he also became exceedingly angry because they were unable to answer Iob with opposing arguments, and determined him to be ungodly.

4 And Elious waited to give Iob an answer, because they are older than he in days.

5 And Elious saw that there is no answer in the mouth of the three men, and his anger grew furious.

6 And Elious, the son of Barachiel, the Bouzite, taking up the discourse, said, I am indeed younger in time, and you are older; therefore I kept quiet, afraid to announce my own knowledge to you;

7 and I said that time is what speaks, and in many years they know wisdom.

8 But there is a spirit in mortals, and it is the Almighty's breath which teaches;

9 those of many years are not wise, nor do the aged know judgment.

10 Therefore I said, Hear me, and I will announce to you what I know;

11 give ear to my words; for I will speak while you hear, until you examine words.

12 And I will attend as far as you, and behold, there was no one reproving Iob, answering his words, from among you,

13 so that you may not say, We found wisdom by adding to the Lord;

14 and you permitted a human to speak such words. –

15 They were terrified; they answered no further; they made words old from themselves.

16 I waited, for they did not speak; because they stood, they did not answer.

17 And Elious, taking up the discourse, says,

18 I will speak again; for I am full of words, for the spirit of the belly is destroying me;

19 and my belly is like a wineskin of new wine, boiling, tied up, or like a smith's bellows, burst.

20 I will speak, so that I may rest, opening my lips;

21 for I will certainly not be ashamed before a human, nor indeed will I show deference to a mortal;

22 for I do not know how to admire a face; otherwise, moths will eat me too.

Chapter 33

1 Nevertheless, hear my words, Iob, and give ear to my speech;

2 for behold, I opened my mouth, and my tongue spoke.

3 My heart is pure in words, and the understanding of my lips is pure in thought.

4 A divine spirit is what made me, and the Almighty's breath is what teaches me.

5 If you can, give me an answer to these things; wait, stand against me, and I against you.

6 You have been formed from clay as I also have; from the same thing we have been formed.

7 Fear of me will not whirl you about, nor will my hand be heavy upon you.

8 Yet you spoke in my ears; I have heard the voice of your words;

9 because you say, I am pure, not having sinned, and I am blameless, for I did not act lawlessly;

10 but he found blame against me, and has considered me as an adversary;

11 and he placed my foot in wood, and watched all my ways.

12 For how do you say, I am righteous, and he has not heard me? For the one above mortals is everlasting.

13 And you say, Why has he not heard every word of my case?

14 For in the Lord's speaking once, and in the second time, a dream,

15 or in a nocturnal meditation, as when dreadful fear falls upon humans during slumbers upon a bed;

16 then he uncovers humans' mind; in such forms of fear he frightened them greatly,

17 to turn a human away from injustice, and he rescued his body from a fall.

18 And he spared his soul from death, and from his falling in war.

19 And again he reproved him with sickness upon a bed, and the multitude of his bones grew numb,

20 and he will certainly not be able to receive any edible food, and his soul will desire eating,

21 until his flesh rots and he shows his bones bare;

22 and his soul drew near to death, and his life is in Hades.

23 If there are a thousand death-bearing angels, one of them will certainly not wound him; if he understands in his heart to turn to the Lord, and declares to a human his own blame, and shows his folly,

24 he will hold fast to preventing his falling into death, and will renew his body like plaster upon a wall, and will fill his bones with marrow;

25 and he will soften his flesh like an infant's, and will restore him, grown to manhood, among humans.

26 And having prayed to the Lord, it will also be acceptable to him, and he will enter with a pure face, with confession; and he will render righteousness to humans.

27 Then at that time the human himself will blame himself, saying, What things I was accomplishing, and he did not examine me in a manner worthy of the things in which I sinned.

28 Save my soul from coming into corruption, and my life will see light.

29 Behold, the strong one works all these things three ways with a man.

30 But he rescued my soul from death, so that my life may praise him in light.

31 Give ear, Iob, and hear me; be silent, and I myself will speak.

32 If there are words, answer me; speak, for I want you to be justified.

33 If not, you hear me; be silent, and I will teach you wisdom.

Chapter 34

1 And Elious, taking up the discourse, says,

2 Hear me, wise ones; knowledgeable ones, give ear to what is good;

3 because an ear tests words, and a throat tastes food.

4 Let us choose judgment for ourselves; let us know among ourselves what is good.

5 Because Iob has said, I am righteous; the Lord removed my judgment,

6 and lied in my judgment; my arrow is violent, without injustice.

7 What man is like Iob, drinking derision like water,

8 not having sinned or acted ungodly, or shared a way with those doing lawless things, to walk with the ungodly?

9 For do not say that there will be no inspection of a man; and there is an inspection for him from the Lord.

10 Therefore, understanding ones in heart, hear me: May it not be mine to act ungodly before the Lord, and to disturb what is righteous before the Almighty;

11 but he repays a human according as each of them does, and in a man's path he will find him.

12 And do you think the Lord will do improper things? Or will the Almighty disturb judgment?

13 He who made the earth; and who is the one making what is beneath heaven and all the things within it?

14 For if he wished to hold fast and to retain the spirit with himself,

15 all flesh will die together, and every mortal will depart into earth, from which he also was formed.

16 And if he does not admonish, hear these things; give ear to a voice of words.

17 See for yourself the one hating lawless things, and the one destroying the wicked, being everlastingly righteous.

18 Ungodly is the one saying to a king, You act lawlessly; Most ungodly one, to the rulers;

19 who was not ashamed before an honored one's face, nor knows how to assign honor to the great so that their faces may be admired.

20 And their crying out and begging a man will turn out empty for them; for they acted unlawfully while the powerless were being turned aside.

21 For he himself is an observer of humans' works, and none of what they do has escaped his notice,

22 nor will there be a place for those doing lawless things to hide;

23 because he will not place upon a man any further; for the Lord surveys all,

24 the one comprehending untraceable things, glorious and extraordinary, of which there is no number;

25 the one knowing their works, and he will turn night, and they will be humbled.

26 And he extinguished the ungodly, and they are visible before him,

27 because they turned aside from God's law, and did not recognize his ordinances,

28 so as to bring upon him a needy man's cry, and he will hear a cry of the poor.

29 And he himself will provide quiet, and who will condemn? And he will hide a face, and who will see him? Both against a nation and against a human together,

30 making a hypocritical human king because of a people's difficulty.

31 Because the one saying to the strong one, I have taken; I will not take a pledge;

32 apart from myself I will see; you show me; if I worked injustice, I will certainly not add to it.

33 Will he repay it from you? Because you will reject, because you will choose, and not I; and what you have known, speak.

34 Therefore understanding ones in heart will say these things, and a wise man has heard my word.

35 But Iob did not speak with understanding, and his words were not with knowledge.

36 Nevertheless, learn, Iob; do not give an answering reply any further, like the senseless,

37 so that we may not add to our sins; and lawlessness will be reckoned upon us, as we speak many words against the Lord.

Chapter 35

1 And Elious, taking up the discourse, says,

2 What is this you considered in judgment? Who are you, that you said, I am righteous before the Lord?

3 Or will you say, What will I do, having sinned?

4 I will give an answer to you and to your three friends.

5 Look up into heaven and see, and observe clouds, how high they are above you.

6 If you sinned, what will you do? And if you also acted lawlessly in many things, what can you do?

7 But since, then, you are righteous, what will you give him? Or what will he receive from your hand?

8 Your ungodliness is for a man like you, and your righteousness for a son of man.

9 Slandered by a multitude, they will cry out; they will shout because of the arm of many.

10 And he did not say, Where is God who made me, who appoints night watches,

11 who distinguishes me from earth's quadrupeds, and from heaven's birds?

12 There they will cry out, and he will certainly not hear, also because of the insolence of wicked ones.

13 For the Lord does not wish to see improper things; for the Almighty himself is an observer

14 of those accomplishing lawless things, and will save me. And be judged before him, if you can praise him as he is.

15 And now, because there is no one inspecting his anger, and he did not know greatly in a transgression;

16 and Iob opens his mouth vainly; in ignorance he weighs down words.

Chapter 36

1 And Elious, adding still further, says,

2 Wait for me a little longer, so that I may teach you; for there is still speech in me.

3 Taking up my knowledge from afar, and by my works I will speak righteous things,

4 in truth, and not unjust words; you understand unjustly.

5 And know that the Lord will certainly not reject the innocent. Mighty in strength of heart,

6 he will certainly not give life to an ungodly man, and will give judgment for the poor.

7 He will not take his eyes away from a righteous man; and with kings upon a throne, and he will seat them for strife, and they will be exalted.

8 And if, bound in fetters, they are held fast in cords of poverty,

9 he will also announce to them their works and their transgressions, because they will be strong.

10 But he will hear the righteous man; and he said that they will turn from injustice.

11 If they hear and serve, they will finish their days in good things, and their years in comeliness.

12 But he does not save the ungodly, because they do not wish to know the Lord, and because, being admonished, they were disobedient.

13 And hypocrites in heart will appoint wrath; they will not shout, because he bound them.

14 Therefore may their soul die in youth, and their life be wounded by angels,

15 in return for their afflicting a weak and powerless man; and he will set forth judgment for the meek.

16 And furthermore he deceived you out of an enemy's mouth; an abyss, a pouring down beneath it; and your table came down full of fatness.

17 And judgment will not be lacking from the righteous,

18 and wrath will be upon the ungodly because of the ungodliness of gifts which they received for injustices.

19 Let not the mind willingly turn you aside from the supplication of powerless ones in necessity, and all those strengthening strength.

20 Do not draw out the night for peoples to go up in their place;

21 but guard yourself lest you do improper things; for this you chose out of poverty.

22 Behold, the strong one will strengthen in his strength; for who is a ruler like him?

23 And who is the one examining his works? Or who is the one saying, He did unjust things?

24 Remember that his works are great, of which men began;

25 every human saw in himself, as many mortals as are wounded.

26 Behold, the strong one is great, and we will not know; the number of his years is also limitless.

27 And drops of rain are numbered by him, and will be poured forth as rain into a cloud;

28 old things will flow, and he overshadowed clouds upon unspeakably many mortals.

28 a He set a season for cattle, and they know the order of a resting place.

29 At all these things, does your thought not stand astonished, nor does your heart depart from your body? And if he understands extensions of a cloud, the evenness of his tent,

30 behold, he stretches edo upon him, and covered the roots of the sea.

31 For by them he will judge peoples; he will give food to the strong.

32 Upon hands he covered light, and gave a command concerning it at its meeting;

33 he will announce concerning it to his friend; possession, also concerning injustice.

Chapter 37

1 And at this my heart was troubled, and flowed away from its place.

2 Hear a report in the anger of the Lord's wrath, and a meditation will come forth from his mouth.

3 Beneath all heaven is his rule, and his light is upon the wings of the earth.

4 Behind him a voice will shout; he will thunder with the voice of his insolence, and will not exchange them, because he will hear his voice.

5 The strong one will thunder wondrous things with his voice; for he did great things which we did not know,

6 commanding snow, Be upon the earth; and a storm of rain, and a storm of rains of his dominion.

7 In the hand of every human he seals up, so that every human may know his own weakness.

8 And beasts entered beneath a shelter, and rested upon a bed.

9 Whirlwinds come from chambers, and cold from extremities.

10 And from the strong one's breath he will give frost, and steers the water however he wishes;

11 and a cloud molds a chosen thing; a cloud will scatter his light.

12 And he himself will turn circuits about in theeboulatho for their works; all things, whatever he commands them, these have been appointed by him upon the earth,

13 whether for discipline, whether for his earth, whether for mercy he will find him.

14 Give ear to these things, Iob; stand, consider the Lord's power.

15 We know that God established his works, making light out of darkness.

16 And he knows a distinction of clouds, and the extraordinary falls of wicked ones.

17 And your robe is warm; and there is quiet upon the earth.

18 You will make firm with him for old things, strong as the appearance of a casting.

19 Why? Teach me what we will say to him; and let us cease saying many things.

20 Has a book or a scribe stood beside me, so that, standing, I may silence a human?

21 And the light is not visible to all; it shines afar in the old things, like that from him upon clouds.

22 From the north, clouds gleaming with gold; upon these are the Almighty's great glory and honor.

23 And we do not find another like him in strength; the one judging righteous things—do you not think he hears?

24 Therefore humans will fear him, and the wise in heart will also fear him.

Chapter 38

1 And after Elious ceased his speech, the Lord said to Iob through a tempest and clouds,

2 Who is this who hides counsel from me, and holds words in his heart, and thinks to hide them from me?

3 Gird your loin like a man, and I will ask you, and you answer me.

4 Where were you when I founded the earth? And tell me, if you know understanding.

5 Who set its measures, if you know? Or who is the one bringing a cord upon it?

6 Upon what have its rings been fixed? And who is the one laying a cornerstone upon it?

7 When stars came into being, all my angels praised me with a great voice.

8 And I fenced in the sea with gates, when it raged, coming forth from its mother's belly;

9 and I appointed a cloud as its clothing, and swaddled it in mist;

10 and I appointed boundaries for it, placing bars and gates around it;

11 and I said to it, Until this point you will come, and will not pass beyond, but in yourself your waves will be crushed.

12 Have I appointed morning brightness in your time, and did the dawn-bringer see its own order,

13 to seize the wings of earth, to shake the ungodly out of it?

14 Did you take earth, mold clay into a living being, and place him upon earth able to speak?

15 And did you remove the light from the ungodly, and crush the arm of the arrogant?

16 And did you come upon a spring of the sea, and walk in the tracks of an abyss?

17 And are the gates of death opened to you in fear, and did the gatekeepers of Hades cower on seeing you?

18 And have you considered the breadth of what is beneath heaven? Tell me, then, how great it is.

19 And in what land does light lodge, and what is the place of darkness?

20 Would you lead me into their boundaries? And do you also know their paths?

21 I know, then, that you have been born at that time, and the number of your years is great.

22 And you came upon treasuries of snow, and have seen treasuries of hail.

23 And it is laid away for you for a time of enemies, for a day of war and battle.

24 And from where does frost come forth, or a south wind disperse into what is beneath heaven?

25 And who prepared a flow for violent rain, and a way for uproars,

26 to rain upon a land where there is no man, a wilderness where no human exists in it,

27 to satisfy an untrodden and uninhabited place, and to make a sprouting of grass grow forth?

28 Who is rain's father? And who is the one who has begotten lumps of dew?

29 And from whose womb does ice come forth? And who has begotten frost in heaven,

30 which descends like flowing water? And who froze the face of an abyss?

31 And did you understand the bond of the Pleiad, and open Orion's barrier?

32 Will you open mazouroth in its time, and lead the evening star by its hair—these things?

33 And do you know heaven's turnings, or the things happening together beneath heaven?

34 And will you call a cloud with a voice, and will it obey you with a trembling of violent water?

35 And will you send thunderbolts, and will they go? And will they say to you, What is it?

36 And who gave women wisdom of weaving, or knowledge of embroidery?

37 And who is the one numbering clouds with wisdom, and inclined heaven to earth?

38 And dust has been poured out like earth, and I have glued it together like a cube to a stone.

39 And will you hunt food for lions, and fill the souls of dragons?

40 For they have been afraid in their beds, and sit in woods lying in wait.

41 And who prepared food for a raven? For its young have cried to the Lord, wandering, seeking food.

Chapter 39

1 Have you known the time of birth of rock goat-stags, and watched the birth-pains of deer?

2 And did you count their months fulfilled for birth, and release their birth-pains?

3 And did you rear their little ones outside fear? Will you send away their birth-pains?

4 They will break away their children; they will multiply in offspring, will go forth, and will certainly not return to them.

5 And who is the one letting a wild ass go free, and who loosened its bonds?

6 And I appointed its dwelling a wilderness, and its habitations a salt land;

7 laughing at a city's great crowd, and not hearing a tax collector's blame,

8 it will survey mountains as its pasture, and seeks after every green thing.

9 And will a unicorn wish to serve you, or sleep at your manger?

10 And will you bind its yoke with straps, or will it draw your furrows in a plain?

11 And have you trusted in it because its strength is great, and will you leave your works to it?

12 And will you believe that it will return the seed to you, and bring in your threshing floor?

13 A wing of rejoicing ones, neelasa, if it takes together asida and nessa;

14 because she will leave her eggs upon earth, and will warm them upon dust,

15 and forgot that a foot will scatter them and beasts of a field will trample them;

16 she hardened herself against her children as though they were not hers; she toiled in vain without fear;

17 because God kept wisdom silent for her, and did not give her a share in understanding.

18 At a time she will lift high on high; she will laugh at a horse and its rider.

19 Did you clothe a horse with power, and clothe its neck with fear?

20 And did you clothe it with full armor, and the glory of its breast with daring?

21 Digging up in a plain, it exults, and goes forth into a plain in strength;

22 meeting a missile, it laughs, and will certainly not turn away from iron;

23 upon it a bow and sword exult,

24 and in anger it will obliterate the earth, and will certainly not believe until a trumpet signals;

25 and when a trumpet signals, it says, Well done; and from afar it smells war, with leaping and shouting.

26 And by your knowledge has a hawk stood, spreading its wings, motionless, looking down upon the things toward the south?

27 And at your command does an eagle rise high, and a vulture, seated upon its nest, lodge

28 upon a prominence of rock and a hidden place?

29 Being there, it seeks food; from afar its eyes watch;

30 and its young are drenched in blood, and wherever dead ones are, they are found immediately.

Chapter 40

1 And the Lord God answered Iob and said,

2 Will he turn aside judgment with the Sufficient One? Will one reproving God answer it?

3 And Iob, taking up the discourse, says to the Lord,

4 Why am I still being judged, being admonished and reproving the Lord, hearing such things, being nothing? And what answer should I give to these things? I will place a hand upon my mouth;

5 I have spoken once, and at the second time I will not add.

6 And the Lord, taking up the discourse again, said to Iob from the cloud,

7 No, but gird your loin like a man, and I will ask you, and you answer me;

8 do not reject my judgment. And do you think I have spoken to you otherwise than so that you may be shown righteous?

9 Do you have an arm against the Lord, or do you thunder with a voice like him?

10 Take up, then, loftiness and power, and clothe yourself with glory and honor;

11 and send angels in anger, and humble every insolent one,

12 and extinguish an arrogant one, and rot the ungodly immediately,

13 and hide them in earth outside together, and fill their faces with dishonor;

14 then I will acknowledge that your right hand can save. –

15 But indeed, behold, beasts beside you; it eats grass like oxen.

16 Behold, indeed, its strength is upon its loin, and its power upon the navel of its belly;

17 it set up a tail like a cypress, and its sinews have been interwoven;

18 its ribs are bronze ribs, and its spine is cast iron.

19 This is the beginning of the Lord's formation, made to be played with by his angels.

20 And coming upon a sheer mountain, it made joy for quadrupeds in Tartarus;

21 it sleeps beneath trees of every sort, beside papyrus and reed and flowering rush;

22 and great trees with shoots, and branches of chaste tree, are shaded in it.

23 If a flood occurs, it will certainly not perceive it; it has trusted that the Iordan will strike against its mouth.

24 In its eye will he receive it, and, ensnaring it, pierce a nose? –

25 And will you lead a dragon with a hook, and place a halter around its nose?

26 Will you bind a ring in its nostril, and pierce its lip with a bracelet?

27 And will it speak to you with entreaty, with supplication softly?

28 And will it make a covenant with you, and will you take it as an everlasting slave?

29 And will you play with it like a bird, or bind it like a little sparrow for a child?

30 And do nations feed upon it, and do races of Phoenicians divide it?

31 And every floating vessel, gathered together—they will certainly not carry one skin of its tail, nor its head in fishermen's boats.

32 And will you lay a hand upon it, remembering the war occurring in its body? And let it happen no longer.

Chapter 41

1 Have you not seen it, nor marveled at the things spoken?

2 Have you not been afraid because it has been prepared for me? For who is the one standing against me?

3 Or who will stand against me and endure, if everything beneath heaven is mine?

4 I will not be silent because of it, and it will pity its equal as regards a word of power.

5 Who will uncover the face of its clothing? And who would enter into the fold of its breastplate?

6 Who will open the gates of its face? Around its teeth is fear.

7 Its inward parts are bronze shields, and its bond is like an emery stone;

8 one sticks to another, and breath will certainly not pass through it;

9 a man will stick to his brother; they are held together and will certainly not be pulled apart.

10 In its sneezing brightness shines, and its eyes are the appearance of the dawn-bringer.

11 Burning torches come forth from its mouth, and hearths of fire are hurled about;

12 from its nostrils comes smoke of a furnace burning with a fire of coals;

13 its soul is coals, and a flame comes forth from its mouth.

14 And power lodges in its neck; destruction runs before it.

15 And the flesh of its body has been glued together; he pours upon it; it will not be shaken.

16 Its heart has been fixed like a stone, and stands like an unhammered anvil.

17 And when it turns, there is fear for quadruped beasts leaping upon earth.

18 If lances meet it, they will certainly do nothing, a raised spear and breastplate;

19 for it has considered iron straw, and copper like rotten wood;

20 a bronze bow will certainly not wound it; it has considered a stone-thrower grass;

21 hammers were reckoned as stubble, and it laughs at the shaking of a fire-bearer.

22 Its bedding is sharp spits, and all the gold of the sea beneath it is like unspeakably much clay.

23 It makes the abyss boil like a bronze pot, and has considered the sea like an ointment vessel,

24 and the Tartarus of the abyss like a captive; it reckoned the abyss a walking place.

25 There is nothing upon earth like it, made to be played with by my angels;

26 it sees every lofty thing, and it is king of all those in the waters.

Chapter 42

1 And Iob, taking up the discourse, says to the Lord,

2 I know that you can do all things, and nothing is impossible for you.

3 For who is the one hiding counsel from you? And, sparing words, does he think to hide it from you too? And who will announce to me what I did not know, great and wondrous things which I did not understand?

4 And hear me, Lord, so that I too may speak; and I will ask you, and you teach me.

5 Indeed, formerly I heard you by an ear's hearing, but now my eye has seen you;

6 therefore I despised myself and melted away, and have considered myself earth and ashes.

7 And it happened after the Lord spoke all these words to Iob, the Lord said to Eliphas the Thaimanite, You sinned, and your two friends; for you did not speak anything true before me, as my attendant Iob did.

8 But now take seven calves and seven rams, and go to my attendant Iob, and he will make a burnt offering for you; and Iob my attendant will pray for you, for surely I will accept his face; for if not for him, I would have destroyed you; for you did not speak what is true against my attendant Iob. –

9 And Eliphas the Thaimanite and Baldad the Sauchite and Sophar the Minaite went and did as the Lord commanded them, and he released their sin for them through Iob.

10 And the Lord increased Iob; and when he also prayed for his friends, he forgave them their sin; and the Lord gave double whatever Iob had before, for a doubling.

11 And all his brothers and his sisters heard all the things that had happened to him, and came to him, and all who knew him from the first; and eating and drinking with him, they comforted him, and marveled at all the things which the Lord brought upon him; and each gave him one ewe-lamb and an unstamped golden tetradrachm.

12 And the Lord blessed Iob's latter things more than the former; and his cattle were fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, a thousand yokes of oxen, a thousand grazing female asses.

13 And seven sons and three daughters are born to him;

14 and he called the first Day, the second Cassia, and the third Amaltheia's Horn;

15 and none better than Iob's daughters were found, compared with them, beneath heaven; and their father gave them an inheritance among their brothers.

16 And Iob lived a hundred seventy years after the stroke, and in all lived two hundred forty-eight years; and Iob saw his sons and his sons' sons, a fourth generation;

17 and Iob died, old and full of days.

17 a And it has been written that he will rise again with those whom the Lord raises. – –

18 This man is interpreted from the Syriac book as dwelling in the land of Ausitis, upon the boundaries of Idoumaia and Arabia, and his name previously was Iobab;

19 and taking an Arabian wife, he begets a son, whose name is Ennon; and he himself was a son of his father Zare, of the sons of Esau, and of his mother Bosorra, so that he was fifth from Abraam.

18 And these are the kings who reigned in Edom, which land he himself also ruled: first Balak the son of Beor, and the name of his city was Dennaba; and after Balak, Iobab, who is called Iob; and after this man, Asom, who was a ruler from the land of Thaimanitis; and after this man, Adad son of Barad, who cut down Madiam in the plain of Moab, and the name of his city was Getthaim.

19 And the friends who came to him: Eliphas, of the sons of Esau, king of the Thaimans; Baldad, the tyrant of the Sauchaians; Sophar, the king of the Minaians.

Wisdom of Solomon

Chapter 1

1 Love righteousness, you who judge the earth; think concerning the Lord in goodness, and seek him in simplicity of heart.

2 Because he is found by those who do not test him, and appears to those who do not disbelieve him.

3 For crooked reasonings separate from God, and power, when tested, reproves the senseless.

4 Because wisdom will not enter a soul devising evil, nor dwell in a body indebted to sin.

5 For a holy spirit of discipline will flee deceit, and depart from reasonings without understanding, and will be reproved when injustice comes upon it.

6 For wisdom is a spirit loving humans, and will not acquit a blasphemer of his lips; because God is a witness of his kidneys, and a true overseer of his heart, and a hearer of his tongue.

7 Because the Lord's spirit has filled the inhabited world, and that which holds all things together has knowledge of a voice.

8 Therefore no one uttering unjust things will escape notice, nor will justice, reproving, pass him by.

9 For there will be an examination into an ungodly man's counsels, and a hearing of his words will come to the Lord for reproof of his lawless deeds;

10 because an ear of jealousy listens to all things, and a murmur of grumblings is not hidden.

11 Therefore guard yourselves against unprofitable grumbling, and spare your tongue from speaking against others; because a secret utterance will not go empty, and a mouth telling lies destroys a soul.

12 Do not pursue death in the wandering of your life, nor draw destruction upon yourselves by the works of your hands;

13 because God did not make death, nor delights in the destruction of the living.

14 For he created all things to exist, and the world's origins are salutary, and there is no poison of destruction in them, nor a kingdom of Hades upon earth.

15 For righteousness is immortal.

16 But the ungodly summoned him with their hands and words; considering him a friend, they melted away, and made an agreement with him, because they are worthy to be of his portion.

Chapter 2

1 For they said among themselves, reasoning incorrectly, Our life is short and sorrowful, and there is no healing at a human's death, and no one who returned from Hades was known.

2 Because we came into being by chance, and after this we will be as though we had not existed; because the breath in our nostrils is smoke, and reason a spark in the movement of our heart,

3 which, when extinguished, the body will become ash, and the spirit will be dispersed like loose air.

4 And our name will be forgotten in time, and no one will remember our works; and our life will pass away like traces of a cloud, and will be scattered like mist, chased by rays of the sun and weighed down by its heat.

5 For our time is a shadow's passing, and there is no returning of our end, because it was sealed, and no one turns back.

6 Come, then, and let us enjoy the good things that exist, and use creation eagerly as in youth;

7 let us be filled with costly wine and perfumes, and let no flower of spring pass us by;

8 let us crown ourselves with rosebuds before they wither;

9 let none of us be without a share of our arrogance; everywhere let us leave tokens of gladness, because this is our portion and this our lot.

10 Let us oppress a needy righteous man, let us not spare a widow, nor show deference to an old man's gray hair of many years;

11 and let our strength be a law of righteousness, for what is weak is proved useless.

12 Let us lie in wait for the righteous man, because he is inconvenient to us, and opposes our works, and reproaches us with sins against law, and charges us with sins against our discipline;

13 he professes to have knowledge of God, and calls himself a servant of the Lord;

14 he became for us a reproof of our thoughts; he is burdensome to us even when seen,

15 because his life is unlike the others', and his paths are different;

16 we were reckoned counterfeit by him, and he abstains from our ways as from impurities; he pronounces the last things of the righteous blessed, and boasts of God as father.

17 Let us see if his words are true, and test the things at his outcome;

18 for if the righteous man is a son of God, he will help him, and rescue him from the hand of those opposing him.

19 With insult and torture let us examine him, so that we may know his gentleness, and test his endurance of evil;

20 let us condemn him to a shameful death, for there will be an inspection of him according to his words.

21 These things they reasoned, and were led astray; for their wickedness blinded them,

22 and they did not know God's mysteries, nor hope for a wage of holiness, nor discern an honor of blameless souls.

23 Because God created the human for incorruptibility, and made him an image of his own eternity;

24 but through the devil's envy death entered the world, and those who are of his portion experience it.

Chapter 3

1 But the souls of the righteous are in God's hand, and torture will certainly not touch them.

2 They seemed in the eyes of the senseless to have died, and their departure was reckoned affliction,

3 and their journey from us, ruin; but they are in peace.

4 For even if they are punished in humans' sight, their hope is full of immortality;

5 and disciplined in a few things, they will be benefited in great things, because God tested them and found them worthy of himself;

6 like gold in a crucible he tested them, and like a whole burnt offering of sacrifice he accepted them.

7 And in the time of their inspection they will shine forth, and like sparks in stubble they will run through;

8 they will judge nations and rule peoples, and the Lord will reign over them for the ages.

9 Those who have trusted in him will understand truth, and those faithful in love will remain with him; because grace and mercy are for his chosen ones.

10 But the ungodly will have punishment according as they reasoned, those who neglected the righteous man and departed from the Lord;

11 for the one despising wisdom and discipline is miserable, and their hope is empty, and their labors unprofitable, and their works useless;

12 their wives are senseless, and their children wicked; their offspring is accursed.

13 Because blessed is the barren woman who is undefiled, who did not know a bed in transgression; she will have fruit in the inspection of souls,

14 and the eunuch who did not work a lawless deed with his hand, nor think wicked things against the Lord; for a choice grace of faith will be given him, and a more pleasing lot in the Lord's temple.

15 For the fruit of good toils is glorious, and the root of prudence unfailing.

16 But adulterers' children will be unfulfilled, and seed from an unlawful bed will be obliterated.

17 For even if they become long-lived, they will be reckoned as nothing, and their old age dishonored at the last;

18 and if they die swiftly, they will have no hope, nor consolation in a day of discernment;

19 for the ends of an unjust generation are harsh.

Chapter 4

1 Better is childlessness with virtue; for immortality is in its remembrance, because it is known both with God and with humans.

2 And when present they imitate it, and long for it when departed; and in the age it proceeds in procession wearing a crown, having won the contest of undefiled prizes.

3 But a prolific multitude of the ungodly will not be useful, and from illegitimate shoots it will not give a root into depth, nor establish a secure foundation;

4 for even if it flourishes in branches for a time, being insecurely established, it will be shaken by wind, and uprooted by the force of winds.

5 Unfulfilled branches will be broken off, and their fruit is useless, unripe for eating, and suitable for nothing;

6 for children born from lawless sleeps are witnesses of wickedness against parents in their examination.

7 But a righteous man, if he dies early, will be in rest;

8 for honored old age is not that of many years, nor has it been measured by a number of years,

9 but prudence is gray hair for humans, and a spotless life is an age of old age.

10 Becoming well-pleasing to God, he was loved, and living among sinners, he was transferred;

11 he was snatched away, lest wickedness change his understanding, or deceit deceive his soul;

12 for the fascination of baseness obscures good things, and the wandering of desire alters an innocent mind.

13 Perfected in a little time, he fulfilled long times;

14 for his soul was pleasing to the Lord; therefore he hastened out of the midst of wickedness; but the peoples, seeing and not understanding, nor placing such a thing upon their thought,

15 that grace and mercy are among his chosen ones, and inspection among his holy ones.

16 And a righteous man who has died will condemn the living ungodly, and youth swiftly completed, an unjust man's old age of many years;

17 for they will see a wise man's end, and will not understand what the Lord planned concerning him, and for what he secured him.

18 They will see and despise; but the Lord will laugh at them,

19 and after this they will become a dishonored corpse, and an insult among the dead throughout an age, because he will dash them headlong, speechless, and shake them from foundations, and they will be laid waste to the last, and will be in pain, and their remembrance will perish.

20 They will come timid in a reckoning of their sins, and their lawless deeds will reprove them from opposite them.

Chapter 5

1 Then the righteous man will stand with great boldness before the face of those who afflicted him, and those rejecting his toils.

2 Seeing him, they will be troubled with dreadful fear, and will be astonished at the unexpectedness of his salvation;

3 they will say among themselves, repenting, and through anguish of spirit they will groan, and will say,

4 This was he whom we, the senseless, once held for laughter and for a proverb of reproach; we reckoned his life madness and his end dishonored.

5 How was he numbered among sons of God, and is his lot among holy ones?

6 Then we were led astray from a way of truth, and the light of righteousness did not shine upon us, and the sun did not rise for us;

7 we were filled with paths of lawlessness and destruction, and traversed untrodden wildernesses, but did not recognize the Lord's way.

8 What did arrogance benefit us? And what has wealth with boastfulness contributed to us?

9 All those things passed like a shadow and like a message running past;

10 like a ship passing through billowing water, of which, when it has crossed, it is not possible to find a trace, nor a track of its keel in waves;

11 or as, when a bird flies through air, no proof of a journey is found, but light wind, lashed by the beating of wings and split by the force of the whirring of moving wings, was traversed, and after this no sign of passage was found in it;

12 or as, when an arrow was shot at a target, the air, cut, immediately returned into itself, so that its passage was unknown;

13 so we too, having been born, ceased, and had no sign of virtue to show, but were wholly consumed in our wickedness.

14 Because an ungodly man's hope is like chaff carried by wind, and like fine frost chased by a tempest, and like smoke it was dispersed by wind, and like the remembrance of a guest of one day it passed away.

15 But the righteous live for the age, and their wage is in the Lord, and care for them is with the Most High.

16 Therefore they will receive the kingdom of comeliness and the diadem of beauty from the Lord's hand, because with his right hand he will shelter them, and with his arm defend them.

17 He will take his zeal as full armor, and arm creation for repelling enemies;

18 he will put on righteousness as a breastplate, and place unhypocritical judgment as a helmet;

19 he will take holiness as an unconquerable shield,

20 and sharpen severe anger into a sword, and the world will wage war together with him against the deranged.

21 Well-aimed missiles of lightning will go forth, and from the clouds, as from a well-curved bow, they will leap toward a target,

22 and hailstones full of wrath will be hurled from a stone-thrower; water of the sea will be indignant against them, and rivers will flood harshly;

23 a wind of power will stand against them, and like a tempest will winnow them out; and lawlessness will lay all the earth waste, and evildoing will overturn rulers' thrones.

Chapter 6

1 Hear, then, kings, and understand; learn, judges of the ends of earth;

2 give ear, you who rule a multitude and have exulted over crowds of nations;

3 because rule was given you from the Lord, and dominion from the Most High, who will examine your works and search out your counsels;

4 because, being servants of his kingdom, you did not judge rightly, nor guard law, nor walk according to God's counsel.

5 Terribly and swiftly he will come upon you, because severe judgment occurs among those in high places.

6 For the least is pardonable through mercy, but the mighty will be examined mightily;

7 for the Master of all will not shrink before a face, nor defer to greatness, because he himself made small and great, and alike provides for all,

8 but a strong investigation comes upon the strong.

9 To you, then, O tyrants, are my words, so that you may learn wisdom and not fall aside;

10 for those who have guarded holy things holily will be made holy, and those taught them will find a defense.

11 Desire, then, my words; long for them, and you will be disciplined.

12 Wisdom is radiant and unfading, and is easily beheld by those loving her, and found by those seeking her;

13 she anticipates those desiring her, to be known beforehand.

14 The one rising early for her will not labor; for he will find her seated beside his gates.

15 For thinking concerning her is perfection of prudence, and the one keeping watch because of her will swiftly be without care;

16 because she herself goes about seeking those worthy of her, and appears to them favorably in their paths, and meets them in every thought.

17 For her beginning is the truest desire for discipline, and care for discipline is love,

18 and love is keeping her laws, and attention to laws is confirmation of incorruptibility,

19 and incorruptibility makes one near God;

20 therefore desire for wisdom leads up to a kingdom.

21 If, then, you delight in thrones and scepters, tyrants of peoples, honor wisdom, so that you may reign for the age.

22 And what wisdom is, and how she came into being, I will announce, and will not hide mysteries from you, but will trace her from the beginning of her origin, and place the knowledge of her in the open, and will certainly not pass truth by.

23 Nor indeed will I journey with wasting envy, because this will not share in wisdom.

24 And a multitude of wise ones is salvation of a world, and a prudent king stability of a people.

25 Therefore be disciplined by my words, and you will be benefited.

Chapter 7

1 Indeed I too am a mortal human, equal to all, and a descendant of the earth-born first-formed man; and in a mother's belly I was sculpted as flesh,

2 congealed in blood in a time of ten months, from a man's seed and pleasure accompanying sleep.

3 And I too, having come into being, drew the common air, and fell upon the earth sharing like experiences, crying as my first voice, the same as all alike;

4 I was reared in swaddling clothes and cares.

5 For none of the kings had another beginning of birth,

6 but the entrance into life is one for all, and the departure equal.

7 Therefore I prayed, and prudence was given me; I called upon him, and a spirit of wisdom came to me.

8 I preferred her to scepters and thrones, and considered wealth nothing in comparison with her;

9 nor did I liken a priceless stone to her, because all gold in her sight is a little sand, and silver will be reckoned as clay before her;

10 above health and beauty of form I loved her, and chose to have her instead of light, because the brightness from her is unsleeping.

11 And all good things came to me together with her, and uncountable wealth in her hands;

12 and I rejoiced over all, because wisdom leads them, but I did not know that she was their mother.

13 And without deceit I learned, and without envy I share; I do not hide her wealth;

14 for she is an unfailing treasure for humans, which those acquiring prepared friendship with God, being commended through the gifts from discipline.

15 And may God grant me to speak according to judgment, and think worthily of the things given, because he himself is both wisdom's guide and the corrector of the wise.

16 For in his hand are both we and our words, and all prudence and knowledge of crafts.

17 For he himself gave me unlying knowledge of things existing, to know the world's constitution and the working of elements,

18 the beginning and end and middle of times, changes of turnings and alterations of seasons,

19 cycles of a year and positions of stars,

20 natures of living beings and tempers of beasts, forces of spirits and reasonings of humans, differences of plants and powers of roots,

21 and whatever things are hidden and manifest I knew; for wisdom, the craftswoman of all, taught me.

22 For in her is a spirit intelligent, holy, only-begotten, of many parts, fine, easily moving, clear, undefiled, plain, unharmed, loving good, sharp,

23 unhindered, beneficent, loving humans, firm, secure, without care, all-powerful, overseeing all, and passing through all intelligent, pure, finest spirits.

24 For wisdom is more mobile than every movement, and penetrates and passes through all things because of her purity;

25 for she is a vapor of God's power, and a pure outflow of the Almighty's glory; therefore nothing defiled falls into her.

26 For she is a radiance of everlasting light, and a spotless mirror of God's working, and an image of his goodness.

27 And being one, she can do all things, and remaining in herself, renews all things, and passing into holy souls generation by generation, makes friends of God and prophets;

28 for God loves nothing except the one dwelling together with wisdom.

29 For she is more comely than the sun, and above every position of stars. Compared with light, she is found prior;

30 for night succeeds this, but wickedness does not prevail over wisdom.

Chapter 8

1 And she extends strongly from end to end, and administers all things kindly.

2 Her I loved and sought out from my youth, and sought to take as a bride for myself, and became a lover of her beauty.

3 She glorifies noble birth, having life together with God, and the Master of all loved her;

4 for she is an initiate in God's knowledge, and a chooser of his works.

5 And if wealth is a desirable possession in life, what is richer than wisdom, who works all things?

6 And if prudence works, who of the things existing is more a craftswoman than she?

7 And if someone loves righteousness, her toils are virtues; for she teaches self-control and prudence, righteousness and courage, than which nothing is more useful in life for humans.

8 And if someone also longs for much experience, she knows ancient things and conjectures future things, understands turns of words and solutions of riddles, foreknows signs and wonders, and outcomes of seasons and times.

9 Therefore I decided to take her to live together, knowing that she will be for me a counselor of good things, and an exhortation in cares and sorrow.

10 Through her I will have glory among crowds, and honor with elders, being young;

11 I will be found sharp in judgment, and admired in rulers' sight;

12 when I am silent, they will wait for me, and when I utter, they will attend, and when I speak at greater length, they will place a hand upon their mouth.

13 Through her I will have immortality, and leave an everlasting remembrance to those after me.

14 I will administer peoples, and nations will be subjected to me;

15 terrible tyrants, hearing, will fear me; among a multitude I will appear good, and in war courageous.

16 Entering my house, I will rest beside her; for her company has no bitterness, nor living together with her pain, but gladness and joy.

17 Reasoning these things in myself, and considering in my heart that there is immortality in kinship with wisdom,

18 and good delight in friendship with her, and unfailing wealth in the toils of her hands, and prudence in training together in her company, and good fame in sharing her words, I went about seeking how I might take her to myself.

19 And I was a child of good nature, and obtained a good soul,

20 or rather, being good, I came into an undefiled body.

21 And knowing that I will not otherwise possess her unless God gives her—and this too was of prudence, to know whose the grace is—I petitioned the Lord and begged him, and said from my whole heart,

Chapter 9

1 God of fathers and Lord of mercy, who made all things by your word,

2 and by your wisdom made a human, so that he may master the creatures brought into being by you,

3 and govern the world in holiness and righteousness, and judge judgment in uprightness of soul,

4 give me wisdom, seated beside your thrones, and do not reject me from your servants.

5 Because I am your slave and a son of your maidservant, a weak and short-lived human, and deficient in understanding of judgment and laws;

6 for even if someone is perfect among sons of humans, with wisdom from you absent he will be reckoned as nothing.

7 You chose me as king of your people and judge of your sons and daughters;

8 you said to build a temple on your holy mountain, and an altar in the city of your dwelling, an imitation of a holy tent which you prepared beforehand from the beginning.

9 And with you is wisdom, who knows your works and was present when you were making the world, and understands what is pleasing in your eyes and what is upright in your commandments.

10 Send her out from holy heavens, and from your throne of glory send her, so that, present together with me, she may labor, and I may know what is well-pleasing with you.

11 For she knows all things and understands, and will guide me with self-control in my actions, and guard me in her glory;

12 and my works will be acceptable, and I will judge your people righteously, and be worthy of my father's thrones.

13 For what human will know God's counsel? Or who will consider what the Lord wills?

14 For mortals' reasonings are timid, and our thoughts insecure;

15 for a corruptible body weighs down a soul, and the earthy tent burdens a mind of many cares.

16 And with difficulty we conjecture things upon earth, and find the things at hand with toil; but who traced the things in heavens?

17 And who knew your counsel, unless you gave wisdom and sent your holy spirit from the highest places?

18 And thus the paths of those upon earth were made straight, and humans were taught the things pleasing to you, and were saved by wisdom.

Chapter 10

1 She guarded the first-formed father of the world, created alone, and delivered him from his own transgression,

2 and gave him strength to rule all things.

3 But an unjust man, departing from her in his anger, perished together with brother-murdering furies.

4 Because of him, when earth was being flooded, wisdom saved it again, piloting the righteous man through cheap wood.

5 She also, when nations in agreement of wickedness were confused, knew the righteous man, and kept him blameless before God, and guarded him strong against compassion for a child.

6 She rescued a righteous man when the ungodly were being destroyed, fleeing the descending fire of the Five Cities,

7 of which a smoking waste still stands as witness of the wickedness, and plants bearing fruit in unfulfilled seasons, and a standing pillar of salt as a memorial of a disbelieving soul.

8 For, passing wisdom by, they were not only harmed by not knowing good things, but also left life a memorial of their senselessness, so that they could not even escape notice in the things in which they stumbled.

9 But wisdom rescued those serving her from toils.

10 She guided a righteous man, a fugitive from a brother's anger, in straight paths; she showed him God's kingdom, and gave him knowledge of holy things; she prospered him in hardships, and multiplied his toils;

11 in the greed of those overpowering him, she stood beside him and made him rich;

12 she guarded him from enemies, and secured him from those lying in wait; and she awarded him a strong contest, so that he might know that piety is mightier than everything.

13 She did not abandon a righteous man who was sold, but rescued him from sin;

14 she went down with him into a pit, and did not leave him in bonds, until she brought him scepters of kingship, and authority over those tyrannizing him; and she showed those blaming him false, and gave him everlasting glory.

15 She rescued a holy people and a blameless seed from a nation of oppressors;

16 she entered a soul of the Lord's attendant, and opposed fearsome kings with wonders and signs.

17 She rendered to holy ones a wage of their labors, guided them in a wondrous way, and became for them a shelter by day, and a flame of stars by night.

18 She brought them across a red sea, and led them through much water;

19 but she flooded their enemies, and cast them up from the depth of an abyss.

20 Therefore righteous ones plundered ungodly ones, and sang hymns to your holy name, Lord, and praised with one accord your hand fighting for them;

21 because wisdom opened the mouth of the mute, and made infants' tongues clear.

Chapter 11

1 She prospered their works in a holy prophet's hand.

2 They traversed an uninhabited wilderness, and pitched tents in untrodden places;

3 they stood against opponents in war, and repelled enemies.

4 They thirsted and called upon you, and water was given them from a sheer rock, and a healing of thirst from a hard stone.

5 For through the things by which their enemies were punished, through these they themselves, being in want, were benefited.

6 Instead of a spring of an ever-flowing river troubled with gore-filled blood,

7 for reproof of a decree murdering infants, you gave them abundant water unexpectedly,

8 showing through the thirst then how you punished the adversaries.

9 For when they were tested, though disciplined in mercy, they knew how ungodly men, judged with anger, were tortured;

10 for these you tested as a father admonishing, but those you examined as a severe king condemning.

11 And absent and present alike they were worn away;

12 for a double sorrow seized them, and a groaning from memories of things past;

13 for when they heard that through their own punishments the others were benefited, they perceived the Lord.

14 For him whom long ago they rejected with mockery, cast out in exposure, at the end of the outcomes they marveled at, having thirsted unlike the righteous.

15 And in return for the uncomprehending reasonings of their injustice, in which, led astray, they worshiped irrational creeping things and cheap beasts, you sent upon them a multitude of irrational living beings for vengeance,

16 so that they might know that by the things through which someone sins, by these he is punished.

17 For your all-powerful hand, which also created the world from formless matter, was not at a loss to send upon them a multitude of bears, or bold lions,

18 or newly-created unknown beasts full of wrath, either blowing a fire-breathing breath, or winnowing a roar of smoke, or flashing dreadful sparks from their eyes,

19 of which not only the harm could destroy them altogether, but also the sight, frightening them greatly, destroy them utterly.

20 And even without these they could fall by one breath, pursued by justice and winnowed by the spirit of your power; but you arranged all things by measure and number and weight.

21 For to be greatly strong is present with you always, and who will stand against the might of your arm?

22 Because the whole world before you is like a tipping of scales, and like a morning drop of dew that descended upon earth.

23 But you have mercy on all, because you can do all things, and overlook humans' sins for repentance.

24 For you love all things existing, and abhor nothing of what you made; for neither would you have made something while hating it.

25 And how would anything have remained if you had not willed, or what was not called by you have been preserved?

26 But you spare all things, because they are yours, Master who loves souls;

Chapter 12

1 for your incorruptible spirit is in all things.

2 Therefore you reprove those falling aside little by little, and, reminding them of the things in which they sin, admonish them, so that, freed from wickedness, they may believe in you, Lord.

3 For also the former inhabitants of your holy land,

4 hating them for doing most hateful things, works of sorceries and unholy rites,

5 and merciless murders of children, and a feast eating entrails of human flesh and blood, initiates from the midst of a ritual band,

6 and parents, murderers of helpless souls, you wished to destroy through our fathers' hands,

7 so that the land most honored of all with you might receive a worthy colony of God's servants.

8 But you spared even these as humans, and sent wasps as forerunners of your army, so that they might destroy them little by little.

9 Not being unable to give the ungodly into the hands of the righteous in battle, or to wipe them out at once with dreadful beasts or a severe word,

10 but judging little by little, you gave a place of repentance, not being ignorant that their origin is wicked, and their wickedness innate, and that their reasoning will certainly not be changed for the age.

11 For it was a seed accursed from the beginning, nor did you give immunity for the things in which they sinned through being wary of anyone.

12 For who will say, What did you do? Or who will stand against your judgment? And who will accuse you concerning nations that have perished, which you made? Or who will come to confront you as an avenger against unjust humans?

13 For neither is there a god except you, who cares for all, so that you should show that you did not judge unjustly,

14 nor will a king or tyrant be able to look you in the face concerning those whom you punished.

15 But being righteous, you govern all things righteously, considering it foreign to your power to condemn the one who ought not to be punished.

16 For your strength is the beginning of righteousness, and your mastering all things makes you spare all things.

17 For you display strength when disbelieved concerning perfection of power, and among those who know, you expose boldness;

18 but you, mastering strength, judge in gentleness, and administer us with much sparing; for the ability is present with you whenever you will.

19 And you taught your people through such works that the righteous man must love humans, and made your sons hopeful, because you give repentance for sins.

20 For if you punished enemies of your servants and those owing death with such attention and indulgence, giving times and a place through which they might be freed from wickedness,

21 with how much exactness did you judge your sons, to whose fathers you gave oaths and agreements of good promises?

22 Therefore, disciplining us, you scourge our enemies ten-thousandfold, so that, judging, we may consider your goodness, and being judged, expect mercy.

23 Therefore also those who lived unjustly in life's senselessness you tortured through their own abominations;

24 for they wandered farther than the ways of error, supposing as gods even the dishonored things among shameful living beings, deceived like senseless infants.

25 Therefore, as to unreasoning children, you sent judgment for mockery.

26 But those not admonished by games of rebuke will experience judgment worthy of God.

27 For at the things through which they themselves, suffering, were indignant, at these, whom they considered gods, being punished by them, seeing him whom long ago they denied knowing, they recognized a true God; therefore also the end of condemnation came upon them.

Chapter 13

1 For all humans were vain by nature, in whom ignorance of God was present, and from the good things seen they were not strong enough to know the one who is, nor, attending to the works, recognized the craftsman,

2 but considered either fire or wind or swift air or a circle of stars or violent water or heaven's luminaries as gods, governors of the world.

3 If, delighting in their beauty, they supposed these gods, let them know how much better than these the Master is, for the originator of beauty created them;

4 but if astonished at power and working, let them understand from them how much mightier the one making them is;

5 for from the greatness and beauty of creatures, their originator is beheld proportionately.

6 But nevertheless upon these there is little blame, for perhaps they themselves also wander while seeking God and wishing to find him;

7 for, moving among his works, they search out, and are persuaded by the sight, because the things seen are beautiful.

8 But again, neither are they pardonable;

9 for if they were strong enough to know so much that they could conjecture the world, how did they not find the Master of these things more swiftly?

10 But miserable are they, and their hopes among the dead, who called works of human hands gods, gold and silver, a work of skill, and likenesses of living beings, or a useless stone, a work of an ancient hand.

11 And if also some woodcutting craftsman, sawing out an easily moved tree, skillfully scraped all its bark around, and, crafting it comely, made a useful vessel for life's service,

12 and, consuming the scraps of the work for preparing food, was filled,

13 but taking the scrap from them useful for nothing, crooked wood grown together with knots, carved it in the care of his leisure, and shaped it with skill of understanding, likened it to a human's image,

14 or made it like some cheap living being, smearing it with red ocher and reddening its color with pigment, and smearing every stain in it,

15 and making for it a dwelling worthy of it, placed it in a wall, securing it with iron.

16 So that it might not fall, then, he provided for it beforehand, knowing that it is unable to help itself; for it is indeed an image, and has need of help.

17 But praying concerning his possessions and marriages and children, he is not ashamed to speak to the soulless thing, and concerning health he calls upon the weak thing,

18 and concerning life asks the dead thing, and concerning assistance supplicates the most inexperienced thing, and concerning a journey, that which cannot even use a step,

19 and concerning gain and work and success of hands, he asks vigor of the thing most inactive with its hands.

Chapter 14

1 Again, someone preparing a voyage, and about to traverse wild waves, calls upon wood more rotten than the boat carrying him.

2 For desire for gains devised that, and wisdom, the craftswoman, made it;

3 but your providence, Father, pilots it, because you gave a way even in sea, and a secure path in waves,

4 showing that you can save from everything, so that someone may embark even without skill.

5 And you wish the works of your wisdom not to be idle; therefore humans entrust souls even to the smallest wood, and passing through a surge on a raft, were saved.

6 For also in the beginning, when arrogant giants were perishing, the world's hope, taking refuge upon a raft, left the world a seed of birth, piloted by your hand.

7 For blessed is wood through which righteousness comes;

8 but the handmade thing is accursed, both it and the one making it, because the one was working, and the corruptible thing was named a god.

9 For equally hateful to God are both the one acting ungodly and his ungodliness;

10 for what was done will also be punished together with the doer.

11 Therefore there will also be an inspection upon idols of nations, because in God's creation they became an abomination, and stumbling blocks for humans' souls, and a snare for feet of the senseless.

12 For the devising of idols is a beginning of fornication, and their invention corruption of life.

13 For neither did they exist from the beginning, nor will they be for the age;

14 for through humans' vainglory they entered the world, and therefore their swift end was devised.

15 For a father worn away by untimely grief, making an image of a child swiftly taken away, honored the formerly dead human now as a god, and handed down mysteries and rites to those under his hand;

16 then, strengthened with time, the ungodly custom was guarded as law.

17 And by tyrants' commands carved things were worshiped; those whom humans could not honor in sight because they dwelt far away, reproducing their appearance from afar, they made a visible image of the honored king, so that through their zeal they might flatter the absent one as present.

18 And the craftsman's ambition urged even those ignorant toward intensified worship;

19 for he, perhaps wishing to please a ruler, forced the likeness toward greater beauty by his skill;

20 and the multitude, drawn by the charm of the workmanship, reckoned the human honored a little before now an object of reverence.

21 And this became an ambush for life, because humans, enslaved either to misfortune or tyranny, placed the incommunicable name upon stones and wood.

22 Then it was not enough to wander concerning the knowledge of God, but also, living in a great war of ignorance, they call such great evils peace.

23 For conducting either child-murdering rites or secret mysteries or frenzied revels of strange customs,

24 they no longer guard either lives or marriages pure, and one either kills another by ambushing, or pains him by adultery.

25 And blood and murder, theft and deceit, corruption, unfaithfulness, disturbance, perjury hold all things mingled together,

26 tumult of good things, forgetfulness of grace, defilement of souls, alteration of birth, disorder of marriages, adultery and licentiousness.

27 For the worship of nameless idols is a beginning and cause and end of every evil;

28 for either rejoicing, they have gone mad, or prophesy false things, or live unjustly, or swear falsely readily;

29 for trusting in soulless idols, having sworn evilly, they do not expect to be harmed.

30 But justice will pursue them for both things, because they thought evilly concerning God, attending to idols, and swore unjustly in deceit, despising holiness;

31 for it is not the power of those by whom they swear, but the justice of sinners, that always pursues the transgression of the unjust.

Chapter 15

1 But you, our God, are kind and true, long-suffering, and administering all things in mercy.

2 For even if we sin, we are yours, knowing your might; but we will not sin, knowing that we have been reckoned to you.

3 For understanding you is whole righteousness, and knowing your might a root of immortality.

4 For neither did humans' evil-devising invention lead us astray, nor the fruitless toil of shadow-painters, a form stained with varied colors,

5 the sight of which comes to the senseless as desire, and he longs for the breathless form of a dead image.

6 Lovers of evils and worthy of such hopes are both those making them and those longing for them and those revering them.

7 For also a potter, pressing soft earth, laboriously molds each thing for our service; but from the same clay he molded both vessels serving clean works and the opposite ones, all alike; and of these, what the use of each of either sort is, the clay-worker is judge.

8 And laboring evilly, he molds a vain god from the same clay, he who, coming into being from earth a little before, after a little goes to that from which he was taken, having been required to pay the debt of his soul.

9 But his care is not that he is about to die, nor that he has a life ending shortly, but he contends with gold-workers and silver-casters, and imitates bronze-molders, and considers it glory that he molds counterfeit things.

10 His heart is ashes, and his hope cheaper than earth, and his life more dishonored than clay,

11 because he did not know the one molding him, and the one breathing into him a working soul, and breathing in a life-giving spirit,

12 but they reckoned our life to be a game, and living a profitable festival, for he says one must gain from wherever, even from evil.

13 For this man, beyond all, knows that he sins, making easily broken vessels and carved things from earthy matter.

14 And all the enemies of your people, who oppressed it, are most senseless and more wretched than an infant's soul,

15 because they reckoned even all the nations' idols gods, which have neither use of eyes for seeing, nor nostrils for drawing air, nor ears to hear, nor fingers of hands for feeling, and their feet are idle for stepping.

16 For a human made them, and one who has borrowed the spirit molded them; for no human is strong enough to mold a god like himself;

17 but being mortal, he works a dead thing with lawless hands; for he is better than his objects of reverence, in that he indeed lived, but those never. –

18 And they revere the most hateful living beings; for compared in folly, they are worse than the others;

19 nor do they happen to be beautiful enough to be desired, as in the appearance of living beings, but they have also escaped God's praise and his blessing.

Chapter 16

1 Therefore through like things they were punished worthily, and through a multitude of beasts were tortured.

2 Instead of which punishment, benefiting your people, you prepared for the desire of appetite a strange taste as food, a quail,

3 so that those, desiring food, through the hideousness of the things sent upon them, might turn away even necessary appetite, but these, becoming needy for a little time, might share even in a strange taste.

4 For it was necessary that unavoidable want come upon those tyrannizing, but that these only be shown how their enemies were tortured.

5 For also when a dreadful fury of beasts came upon them, and they were being destroyed by bites of crooked serpents, your anger did not remain to the end;

6 but for admonition they were troubled for a little time, having a token of salvation for remembrance of the commandment of your law;

7 for the one turning was saved not through what was beheld, but through you, the Savior of all.

8 And by this too you persuaded our enemies that you are the one rescuing from every evil;

9 for bites of locusts and flies killed those, and no healing was found for their soul, because they were worthy to be punished by such things;

10 but not even teeth of venomous dragons overcame your sons, for your mercy came against them and healed them.

11 For they were stung for a reminder of your oracles, and were swiftly saved, so that, falling into deep forgetfulness, they might not become withdrawn from your beneficence.

12 For neither herb nor poultice healed them, but your word, Lord, which heals all.

13 For you have authority over life and death, and bring down into gates of Hades, and bring up;

14 and a human indeed kills by his wickedness, but does not turn back a spirit that has gone out, nor release a soul taken away.

15 But to flee your hand is impossible;

16 for ungodly men, denying knowing you, were scourged in the strength of your arm, pursued by strange rains and hails and unavoidable showers, and consumed by fire.

17 For the most unexpected thing—in water which extinguishes all, the fire worked more, for the world fights for the righteous;

18 for at one time a flame was tamed, so that it might not burn up the living beings sent against the ungodly, but that they themselves, seeing, might know that they are driven by God's judgment;

19 and at another time, even amid water, it burns beyond fire's power, so that it may destroy an unjust land's produce.

20 Instead of these things, you fed your people angels' food, and provided them ready bread from heaven without toil, capable of every pleasure and suited to every taste;

21 for your substance manifested your sweetness toward children, and, serving the desire of the one taking it, it was transformed into whatever someone wished.

22 And snow and ice endured fire and were not melted, so that they might know that fire destroyed the enemies' fruits, burning in the hail and flashing in the rains;

23 but this again, so that righteous ones might be nourished, has forgotten even its own power.

24 For creation, serving you who made it, is intensified for punishment against the unjust, and relaxed for beneficence on behalf of those who have trusted in you.

25 Therefore also then, being altered into all things, it served your all-nourishing gift according to the will of those needing it,

26 so that your sons, whom you loved, Lord, might learn that it is not the origins of fruits that nourish a human, but your word preserves those believing you.

27 For that which was not destroyed by fire, simply being warmed by a short ray of sun, melted,

28 so that it might be known that one must anticipate the sun for thanksgiving to you, and petition you toward the rising of light;

29 for an ungrateful man's hope will melt like wintry frost, and flow like useless water.

Chapter 17

1 For your judgments are great and difficult to recount; therefore undisciplined souls were led astray.

2 For lawless men, supposing they could oppress a holy nation, lay as prisoners of darkness and captives of a long night, shut beneath roofs, fugitives from everlasting providence.

3 For, thinking to escape notice in secret sins beneath a lightless covering of forgetfulness, they were scattered, terribly astonished, and disturbed by apparitions.

4 For neither did the recess holding them guard them without fear, but sounds disturbing them resounded around them, and gloomy phantoms with unsmiling faces appeared.

5 And no force of fire prevailed to illuminate, nor did bright flames of stars endure to light that gloomy night.

6 But only a spontaneous blaze full of fear shone through for them, and, greatly terrified, they considered the things seen worse than that sight not beheld.

7 And mockeries of magical skill lay low, and an insulting exposure of boastfulness concerning prudence;

8 for those promising to drive away terrors and disturbances of a sick soul, these were sick with a laughable apprehension.

9 For even if nothing disturbing frightened them, scared away by beasts passing and creeping things hissing, they perished trembling, refusing even to look upon the air, which can be fled from nowhere.

10 For wickedness, condemned by its own witness, is a timid thing, and, held fast by conscience, has always taken on harsh things;

11 for fear is nothing except a betrayal of the helps from reasoning,

12 and expectation, being weaker within, reckons ignorance greater than the cause providing the torture.

13 But those, sleeping the same sleep through the truly powerless night which also came from the recesses of powerless Hades,

14 were at one time driven by marvels of phantoms, and at another paralyzed by betrayal of the soul; for sudden and unexpected fear was poured upon them.

15 Then thus, whoever indeed was there, falling down, was guarded, shut in the prison without iron;

16 for whether someone was a farmer or shepherd or worker of labors in solitude, overtaken, he endured the necessity difficult to escape, for all were bound with one chain of darkness;

17 whether a hissing wind, or a melodious sound of birds about luxuriant branches, or the rhythm of water going violently, or a harsh crash of rocks hurled down,

18 or an unseen running of leaping living beings, or a voice of roaring, harshest beasts, or an echo reflected from a hollow of mountains, frightening them greatly, paralyzed them.

19 For the whole world was lit by radiant light, and held fast by unhindered works;

20 but upon those alone a heavy night was spread, an image of the darkness about to receive them, and to themselves they were heavier than darkness.

Chapter 18

1 But for your holy ones there was greatest light; hearing their voice but not seeing their form, they pronounced them blessed because those too had not suffered,

2 and because, previously wronged, they do not harm, they gave thanks, and begged favor for the difference.

3 Instead of these things, you provided a pillar burning with fire, a guide of an unknown journey, and a harmless sun of an honorable sojourn abroad.

4 For those were worthy to be deprived of light and imprisoned in darkness, who guarded your sons shut in, through whom the incorruptible light of law was about to be given to the world.

5 And when they planned to kill the infants of the holy ones, and one child was exposed and saved, for reproof you took away their multitude of children, and destroyed them together in violent water.

6 That night was foreknown by our fathers, so that, knowing securely the oaths which they trusted, they might be encouraged.

7 Salvation of righteous ones, and destruction of enemies, was awaited by your people;

8 for by that with which you punished the adversaries, by this you glorified us, calling us to yourself.

9 For in secret holy children of good men sacrificed, and in agreement established the law of divinity, that the holy ones would share alike in the same good things and dangers, already singing beforehand the fathers' praises.

10 And the discordant shout of enemies echoed back, and a pitiable voice of lamented children was carried abroad;

11 and with like justice a slave was punished together with a master, and a commoner suffered the same things as a king,

12 and all together, under one name of death, had uncountable dead; for neither were the living sufficient for burying, since at one tipping their more honored offspring had been destroyed.

13 For disbelieving all things because of the sorceries, at the destruction of the firstborn they acknowledged the people to be God's son.

14 For while quiet silence encompassed all things, and night in its own swiftness was at its middle,

15 your all-powerful word leaped from heavens, from royal thrones, a severe warrior, into the midst of the doomed land, carrying your unhypocritical command as a sharp sword,

16 and, standing, filled all things with death, and indeed touched heaven, but stood upon earth.

17 Then immediately visions of dreadful dreams disturbed them, and unexpected fears came upon them,

18 and one here, another there, flung half-dead, disclosed the cause through which they were dying;

19 for the dreams troubling them indicated this beforehand, so that they might not perish ignorant of that through which they suffer evilly.

20 And an experience of death touched even the righteous, and a breaking of a multitude occurred in a wilderness. But the anger did not remain for long;

21 for a blameless man, hastening, fought for them, bringing the weapon of his own service, prayer and propitiation of incense; he stood against the wrath, and placed an end to the misfortune, showing that he is your attendant;

22 and he overcame the anger not by bodily strength, not by the working of weapons, but by a word subjected the punisher, reminding him of fathers' oaths and covenants.

23 For when dead men had already fallen in heaps upon one another, standing between, he cut off the anger, and severed the way toward the living.

24 For upon a robe reaching the feet was the whole world, and fathers' glories upon a carving of stones in four rows, and your majesty upon the diadem of his head.

25 To these the destroyer yielded, and these he feared; for the experience of the anger alone was sufficient.

Chapter 19

1 But upon the ungodly merciless wrath came to the end; for he also foreknew their future things,

2 that they themselves, permitting departure and sending them forth eagerly, would pursue them, having changed their minds.

3 For still holding their griefs in their hands, and lamenting at graves of the dead, they drew upon themselves another reasoning of folly, and those whom, supplicating, they expelled, these they pursued as fugitives.

4 For deserving necessity drew them to this end, and cast in forgetfulness of the things that had happened, so that they might further complete the punishment lacking to the tortures,

5 and your people might experience an unexpected journey, but those find a strange death.

6 For the whole creation in its own kind was again shaped anew, serving your commands, so that your servants might be guarded unharmed.

7 The cloud overshadowing the camp, and an emergence of dry land from previously existing water was beheld, an unhindered way from a red sea, and a grass-bearing plain from a violent surge;

8 through which those sheltered by your hand passed as an entire nation, beholding wondrous marvels.

9 For like horses they grazed, and like lambs leaped about, praising you, Lord, who rescued them.

10 For they still remembered the things in their sojourn, how instead of the birth of living beings the earth brought forth a gnat, and instead of aquatic beings the river belched forth a multitude of frogs.

11 And later they also saw a new birth of birds, when, led on by desire, they asked for foods of luxury;

12 for as consolation a quail came up for them from sea.

13 And the punishments came upon sinners not without the preceding proofs in the violence of thunderbolts; for they suffered righteously for their own wickednesses, for they also practiced harsher hatred of strangers.

14 For the former did not receive the unknown ones present; but these enslaved strangers who were benefactors.

15 And not only this, but indeed there will be some inspection of them, since they received the outsiders hatefully;

16 but those receiving with festivities the ones who had already shared the same rights afflicted them with dreadful toils.

17 And they were also struck with blindness, like those at the righteous man's doors, when, clothed in gaping darkness, each sought the passage of his own doors.

18 For the elements, being retuned through one another, as notes in a psaltery change the name of the rhythm, always remaining in sound, which it is possible to conjecture precisely from the sight of the things that have happened;

19 for land beings were changed into aquatic beings, and swimming beings went upon earth;

20 fire prevailed in water with its own power, and water forgot its extinguishing nature;

21 conversely, flames did not wither the flesh of easily destroyed living beings walking among them, nor the meltable, ice-like, easily melted kind of ambrosial food.

22 For in all things, Lord, you magnified your people, and glorified them, and did not overlook them, standing beside them in every time and place.

Sirach

Chapter 0

1 Many and great things having been given to us through the law and the prophets

2 and the others who have followed in their manner,

3 for which it is necessary to praise Israel for discipline and wisdom,

4 and since it is necessary that not only the readers themselves become knowledgeable,

5 but also that those loving learning be able to be useful to those outside,

6 both speaking and writing,

7 my grandfather Iesous, having given himself more fully

8 to the reading of the law

9 and of the prophets

10 and of the other ancestral books,

11 and having acquired sufficient proficiency in these,

12 was led himself also to write something of the things pertaining to discipline and wisdom,

13 so that those loving learning, becoming engaged in these things also,

14 might advance much more through lawful living.

15 Therefore you have been exhorted

16 with goodwill and attention

17 to do the reading,

18 and to have forgiveness

19 for the things in which we may seem,

20 in some of the expressions labored over in the translation, to be unable;

21 for they do not have equal force,

22 the things themselves said in Hebrew in themselves, and when transferred into another tongue;

23 and not only these things,

24 but also the law itself and the prophecies

25 and the rest of the books

26 have no small difference when said in themselves.

27 For in the thirty-eighth year under King Euergetes,

28 having arrived in Egypt and spent time there,

29 finding a likeness of no little discipline,

30 I considered it most necessary myself also to bring some zeal and diligence to translate this book,

31 bringing much wakefulness and knowledge

32 in the interval of time,

33 in order, having brought the book to an end, to publish it,

34 and for those in the sojourn wishing to love learning,

35 preparing their characters beforehand,

36 to live lawfully.

Chapter 1

1 All wisdom is from the Lord, and is with him for the age.

2 Who will count the sand of seas and drops of rain and days of an age?

3 Who will trace heaven's height and earth's breadth and an abyss and wisdom?

4 Wisdom has been created prior to all things, and understanding of prudence from an age.

6 To whom was wisdom's root revealed? And who knew her skillful deeds?

8 One is wise, exceedingly fearsome, seated upon his throne.

9 The Lord himself created her, and saw and counted her, and poured her out upon all his works,

10 with all flesh according to his giving, and supplied her to those loving him.

11 Fear of the Lord is glory and boasting and gladness and a crown of exultation.

12 Fear of the Lord will delight a heart, and give gladness and joy and length of days.

13 For the one fearing the Lord it will be well at the last, and on the day of his end he will be blessed.

14 A beginning of wisdom is fearing the Lord, and with faithful ones she was created together for them in a womb.

15 Among humans she nested an everlasting foundation, and with their seed she will be entrusted.

16 Fullness of wisdom is fearing the Lord, and she makes them drunk from her fruits;

17 she will fill their whole house with desirable things, and the storehouses with her produce.

18 A crown of wisdom is fear of the Lord, making peace and health of healing flourish.

19 And he saw and counted her; he showered knowledge and understanding of comprehension, and raised the glory of those holding her.

20 A root of wisdom is fearing the Lord, and her branches are length of days.

22 Unjust wrath will not be able to be justified; for the tipping of his wrath is a fall for him.

23 A long-suffering man will hold fast until a time, and afterward gladness will spring up for him;

24 until a time he will hide his words, and lips of many will recount his understanding.

25 In treasures of wisdom are parables of knowledge, but reverence for God is an abomination to a sinner.

26 Desiring wisdom, preserve commandments, and the Lord will supply her to you.

27 For wisdom and discipline are fear of the Lord, and his good pleasure is faith and meekness.

28 Do not disobey fear of the Lord, and do not approach him with a double heart.

29 Do not act hypocritically in humans' mouths, and attend to your lips.

30 Do not exalt yourself, so that you may not fall and bring dishonor upon your soul; and the Lord will uncover your hidden things, and cast you down in the midst of an assembly, because you did not approach in fear of the Lord, and your heart is full of deceit.

Chapter 2

1 Child, if you approach to serve the Lord, prepare your soul for testing;

2 make your heart straight, and endure, and do not hasten in a time of affliction;

3 cling to him, and do not depart, so that you may be increased at your last things.

4 Receive everything which may be brought upon you, and be long-suffering in changes of your humiliation;

5 because gold is tested in fire, and acceptable humans in a furnace of humiliation.

6 Believe him, and he will help you; make your ways straight, and hope in him.

7 You who fear the Lord, await his mercy, and do not turn aside, so that you may not fall.

8 You who fear the Lord, believe him, and your wage will certainly not fail.

9 You who fear the Lord, hope for good things and for gladness of an age and mercy.

10 Look into ancient generations and see; who trusted in the Lord and was put to shame? Or who remained in his fear and was abandoned? Or who called upon him, and he overlooked him?

11 Because the Lord is compassionate and merciful, and forgives sins and saves in a time of affliction.

12 Woe to timid hearts and slack hands and a sinner stepping upon two paths.

13 Woe to a slack heart, because it does not believe; therefore it will not be sheltered.

14 Woe to you who have lost endurance; and what will you do when the Lord inspects?

15 Those fearing the Lord will not disobey his words, and those loving him will keep his ways.

16 Those fearing the Lord will seek his good pleasure, and those loving him will be filled with the law.

17 Those fearing the Lord will prepare their hearts, and humble their souls before him.

18 We will fall into the Lord's hands, and not into humans' hands; for as his majesty is, so also is his mercy.

Chapter 3

1 Hear me, the father, children, and do thus, so that you may be saved;

2 for the Lord glorified a father over children, and confirmed a mother's judgment over sons.

3 The one honoring a father makes atonement for sins,

4 and the one glorifying his mother is like the one storing treasure.

5 The one honoring a father will be gladdened by children, and will be heard on the day of his prayer.

6 The one glorifying a father will have long days, and the one hearing the Lord will give his mother rest;

7 and he will serve those who begot him as masters.

8 In deed and word honor your father, so that a blessing from him may come upon you;

9 for a father's blessing establishes children's houses, but a mother's curse uproots foundations.

10 Do not be glorified in your father's dishonor, for a father's dishonor is no glory for you;

11 for a human's glory comes from his father's honor, and a mother in disrepute is a reproach to children.

12 Child, help your father in old age, and do not grieve him in his life;

13 and even if he fails in understanding, have forgiveness, and do not dishonor him in all your strength.

14 For mercy toward a father will not be forgotten, and will be built up for you instead of sins.

15 In the day of your affliction you will be remembered; as fair weather upon frost, so your sins will be dissolved.

16 The one abandoning a father is like a blasphemer, and the one angering his mother has been accursed by the Lord.

17 Child, conduct your works in meekness, and you will be loved by an acceptable human.

18 As great as you are, so much humble yourself, and before the Lord you will find grace;

20 because the Lord's dominion is great, and he is glorified by the humble.

21 Do not seek things harder than you, and do not examine things stronger than you;

22 what was commanded you, consider these things, for you have no need of hidden things.

23 Do not meddle in things beyond your works; for things greater than humans' understanding were shown you.

24 For their supposition led many astray, and an evil suspicion made their thoughts slip.

26 A hard heart will be afflicted at the last, and the one loving danger will perish in it.

27 A hard heart will be burdened with toils, and the sinner will add sin upon sins.

28 For an arrogant man's affliction there is no healing; for a plant of wickedness has taken root in him.

29 An understanding man's heart will consider a parable, and a hearer's ear is a wise man's desire.

30 Water will extinguish a flaming fire, and almsgiving will make atonement for sins.

31 The one repaying favors remembers for the things after these, and in the time of his fall will find support.

Chapter 4

1 Child, do not deprive the poor man's life, and do not delay needy eyes.

2 Do not grieve a hungry soul, and do not anger a man in his want.

3 Do not further trouble an angered heart, and do not delay a gift to one needing it.

4 Do not refuse an afflicted suppliant, and do not turn your face away from a poor man.

5 Do not turn an eye away from one begging, and do not give a human a place to curse you;

6 for when he curses you in bitterness of his soul, the one who made him will hear his entreaty.

7 Make yourself beloved by an assembly, and humble your head before a great man.

8 Incline your ear to a poor man, and answer him peaceable things in meekness.

9 Deliver one wronged from the hand of one wronging, and do not lose heart when you judge.

10 Become like a father to orphans, and in place of a husband to their mother; and you will be like a son of the Most High, and he will love you more than your mother.

11 Wisdom raised her sons, and takes hold of those seeking her.

12 The one loving her loves life, and those rising early for her will be filled with gladness.

13 The one holding her will inherit glory, and where he enters, the Lord blesses.

14 Those serving her will minister to a holy one, and the Lord loves those loving her.

15 The one obeying her will judge nations, and the one attending to her will dwell confidently.

16 If he trusts, he will inherit her, and his generations will be in possession;

17 because at first she will walk with him crookedly, bring fear and timidity upon him, and torment him with her discipline, until she trusts his soul, and will test him with her ordinances;

18 and again she will return straight toward him, and gladden him, and reveal her hidden things to him.

19 If he wanders away, she will abandon him, and deliver him into the hands of his fall.

20 Keep a time, and guard yourself from evil, and do not be ashamed concerning your soul;

21 for there is shame bringing sin, and there is shame which is glory and grace.

22 Do not accept a face against your soul, and do not show deference to your fall.

23 Do not withhold a word in a time of need;

24 for in a word wisdom will be known, and discipline in an utterance of a tongue.

25 Do not contradict the truth, and be ashamed concerning your lack of discipline.

26 Do not be ashamed to confess your sins, and do not force a river's flow.

27 And do not lay yourself beneath a foolish human, and do not accept a ruler's face.

28 Struggle for the truth until death, and the Lord God will fight for you.

29 Do not become bold in your tongue, and sluggish and slack in your works.

30 Do not be like a lion in your house, and creating terrors among your household servants.

31 Let your hand not be stretched out for receiving, and drawn in when repaying.

Chapter 5

1 Do not rely upon your wealth, and do not say, It is sufficient for me.

2 Do not follow your soul and your strength to walk in your heart's desires;

3 and do not say, Who will rule me? For the Lord, avenging, will avenge.

4 Do not say, I sinned, and what happened to me? For the Lord is long-suffering.

5 Concerning atonement, do not become fearless to add sin upon sins;

6 and do not say, His compassion is great; he will make atonement for the multitude of my sins; for mercy and anger are with him, and his wrath will rest upon sinners.

7 Do not wait to turn to the Lord, and do not postpone from day to day; for suddenly the Lord's anger will come forth, and in a time of vengeance you will perish.

8 Do not rely upon unjust wealth; for it will benefit you nothing in a day of affliction.

9 Do not winnow in every wind, and do not walk in every path; thus is the double-tongued sinner.

10 Be established in your understanding, and let your word be one.

11 Become swift in your hearing, and utter an answer in long-suffering.

12 If you have understanding, answer your neighbor; but if not, let your hand be upon your mouth.

13 Glory and dishonor are in speech, and a human's tongue is a fall for him.

14 Do not be called a whisperer, and do not lie in wait with your tongue; for shame is upon the thief, and evil condemnation upon the double-tongued.

15 In great and in small do not be ignorant, and instead of a friend do not become an enemy; for an evil name will inherit shame and reproach; thus is the double-tongued sinner.

Chapter 6

1 And instead of a friend do not become an enemy; for an evil name will inherit shame and reproach; thus is the double-tongued sinner.

2 Do not exalt yourself in your soul's counsel, so that your soul may not be torn apart like a bull;

3 you will devour your leaves and destroy your fruits, and leave yourself like a dry tree.

4 An evil soul will destroy the one acquiring it, and make him a delight of enemies.

5 A sweet throat will multiply its friends, and a well-speaking tongue will multiply friendly greetings.

6 Let those at peace with you be many, but your counselors one out of a thousand.

7 If you acquire a friend, acquire him in testing, and do not trust him swiftly.

8 For there is a friend in his own time, and he will certainly not remain in the day of your affliction.

9 And there is a friend changing into enmity, and he will reveal a quarrel for your reproach.

10 And there is a friend sharing tables, and he will certainly not remain in the day of your affliction;

11 and in your good things he will be like you, and speak boldly to your household servants;

12 if you are humbled, he will be against you, and hide from your face.

13 Separate yourself from your enemies, and be attentive concerning your friends.

14 A faithful friend is a strong shelter, and the one finding him found a treasure.

15 There is no exchange for a faithful friend, and no weight of his beauty.

16 A faithful friend is a medicine of life, and those fearing the Lord will find him.

17 The one fearing the Lord will make his friendship straight, because according to himself, so also is his neighbor.

18 Child, from your youth choose discipline, and until gray hairs you will find wisdom.

19 Like the one plowing and the one sowing, approach her, and await her good fruits; for in her work you will labor a little, and swiftly eat of her produce.

20 How exceedingly harsh she is to the undisciplined, and a fainthearted man will not remain in her;

21 like a strong testing stone she will be upon him, and he will not delay to cast her away.

22 For wisdom is according to her name, and is not manifest to many.

23 Hear, child, and receive my judgment, and do not refuse my counsel;

24 and bring your feet into her fetters, and your neck into her collar;

25 put your shoulder beneath her and carry her, and do not be vexed with her bonds;

26 with all your soul approach her, and with your whole power keep her ways;

27 trace and seek, and she will be known to you, and having taken hold, do not let her go;

28 for at the last you will find her rest, and she will turn into gladness for you;

29 and the fetters will be for you a shelter of strength, and her collars a robe of glory.

30 For a golden adornment is upon her, and her bonds are hyacinth-colored thread;

31 you will put her on as a robe of glory, and place a crown of exultation upon yourself.

32 If you will, child, you will be disciplined, and if you give your soul, you will be skillful;

33 if you love hearing, you will receive, and if you incline your ear, you will be wise.

34 Stand among a multitude of elders; and who is wise? Cling to him.

35 Wish to hear every divine account, and let no proverbs of understanding escape you.

36 If you see an understanding man, rise early to him, and let your foot wear away the steps of his doors.

37 Consider the Lord's ordinances, and meditate in his commandments continually; he himself will establish your heart, and the desire of wisdom will be given you.

Chapter 7

1 Do not do evils, and evil will certainly not overtake you;

2 depart from injustice, and it will turn away from you.

3 Son, do not sow upon furrows of injustice, and you will certainly not reap them sevenfold.

4 Do not seek leadership from the Lord, nor a seat of glory from a king.

5 Do not justify yourself before the Lord, and do not display wisdom before a king.

6 Do not seek to become a judge, lest you be unable to remove injustices, lest you become wary before a ruler's face, and place a stumbling block in your uprightness.

7 Do not sin against a city's multitude, and do not cast yourself down in a crowd.

8 Do not bind sin twice; for even in the one you will not be innocent.

9 Do not say, He will look upon the multitude of my gifts, and when I offer to God Most High, he will accept.

10 Do not lose heart in your prayer, and do not overlook doing almsgiving.

11 Do not laugh at a human who is in bitterness of his soul; for there is one who humbles and raises.

12 Do not plow a lie against your brother, nor do the like to a friend.

13 Do not wish to lie any lie; for persistence in it is not for good.

14 Do not chatter in a multitude of elders, and do not repeat a word in your prayer.

15 Do not hate laborious work and farming, created by the Most High.

16 Do not number yourself among a multitude of sinners; remember that anger will not delay.

17 Humble your soul exceedingly, because vengeance upon an ungodly man is fire and a worm.

18 Do not exchange a friend for gain, nor a true brother for gold of Souphir.

19 Do not miss a wise and good wife; for her grace is above gold.

20 Do not afflict a household servant working in truth, nor a hired man giving his soul;

21 let your soul love an understanding household servant; do not deprive him of freedom.

22 Do you have cattle? Inspect them; and if they are useful to you, let them remain with you.

23 Do you have children? Discipline them, and bend their neck from youth.

24 Do you have daughters? Attend to their body, and do not make your face cheerful toward them.

25 Give a daughter in marriage, and you will have completed a great work, and give her to an understanding man.

26 Do you have a wife according to your soul? Do not cast her out; and do not entrust yourself to one hated.

27 With your whole heart glorify your father, and do not forget your mother's birth-pains;

28 remember that through them you were born, and what will you repay them as they did for you?

29 With your whole soul revere the Lord, and admire his priests.

30 With your whole power love the one who made you, and do not abandon his ministers.

31 Fear the Lord and glorify a priest, and give him the portion, as you have been commanded, firstfruit and that concerning transgression, and a gift of shoulders, and a sacrifice of sanctification, and firstfruit of holy things.

32 And stretch out your hand to a poor man, so that your blessing may be perfected.

33 Let the grace of a gift be before every living one, and do not withhold grace upon a dead one.

34 Do not fail those weeping, and mourn with those mourning.

35 Do not hesitate to inspect a sick human; for from such things you will be loved.

36 In all your words remember your last things, and you will not sin for the age.

Chapter 8

1 Do not battle with a powerful human, lest you fall into his hands.

2 Do not quarrel with a rich human, lest he oppose your weight; for gold destroyed many and turned aside kings' hearts.

3 Do not battle with a talkative human, and do not heap wood upon his fire.

4 Do not jest with an undisciplined man, so that your ancestors may not be dishonored.

5 Do not reproach a human turning away from sin; remember that we all are under penalties.

6 Do not dishonor a human in his old age; for some of us too grow old.

7 Do not rejoice over a dead one; remember that we all die.

8 Do not overlook an account of wise ones, and move among their proverbs; because from them you will learn discipline, and to minister to great men.

9 Do not miss an account of elders, for they too learned from their fathers; because from them you will learn understanding, and to give an answer in a time of need.

10 Do not kindle a sinner's coals, lest you be burned in the fire of his flame.

11 Do not rise up before an insolent man's face, so that he may not sit as an ambush for your mouth.

12 Do not lend to a human stronger than you; and if you lend, become as one who has lost it.

13 Do not stand surety beyond your power; and if you stand surety, consider yourself as one who will repay.

14 Do not litigate with a judge; for according to his opinion they will judge for him.

15 Do not walk on a way with a reckless man, so that he may not become burdensome against you; for he himself will do according to his will, and you will perish together with his senselessness.

16 Do not make a quarrel with a wrathful man, and do not traverse the wilderness with him; because blood is as nothing in his eyes, and where there is no help, he will cast you down.

17 Do not take counsel with a fool; for he will not be able to keep a word.

18 Do not do a hidden thing before a stranger; for you do not know what he will bring forth.

19 Do not disclose your heart to every human, and let him not render you favor.

Chapter 9

1 Do not be jealous of the wife of your bosom, nor teach evil discipline against yourself.

2 Do not give your soul to a woman for her to step upon your strength.

3 Do not meet a woman prostituting herself, lest you fall into her snares.

4 Do not linger with a woman playing music, lest you be caught in her attempts.

5 Do not observe a virgin closely, lest you stumble in her penalties.

6 Do not give your soul to prostitutes, so that you may not destroy your inheritance.

7 Do not look around in streets of a city, and do not wander in its deserted places.

8 Turn an eye away from a beautiful woman, and do not observe another's beauty closely; many were led astray by a woman's beauty, and from this affection is kindled like fire.

9 Do not sit at all with a married woman, and do not feast together with her over wine, lest your soul incline toward her, and in your spirit you slip into destruction.

10 Do not abandon an old friend, for a recent one is not equal to him; new wine is a new friend; if it grows old, you will drink it with gladness.

11 Do not envy a sinner's glory; for you do not know what his downfall will be.

12 Do not delight in the good fortune of the ungodly; remember that until Hades they will certainly not be justified.

13 Keep far away from a human who has authority to murder, and you will certainly not suspect fear of death; and even if you approach, do not transgress, so that he may not take away your life; recognize that you cross amid snares, and walk upon a city's battlements.

14 According to your strength, appraise those near you, and take counsel with wise ones.

15 Let your reasoning be with understanding ones, and all your account in the Most High's law.

16 Let righteous men be your fellow diners, and let your boasting be in fear of the Lord.

17 A work will be praised in craftsmen's hands, and a people's leader is wise in his word.

18 A talkative man is fearsome in his city, and the rash in his word will be hated.

Chapter 10

1 A wise judge will discipline his people, and an understanding man's leadership will be ordered.

2 According to the people's judge, so also are his ministers, and according to the city's leader, all its inhabitants.

3 An undisciplined king will destroy his people, and a city will be inhabited in rulers' understanding.

4 The earth's authority is in the Lord's hand, and he will raise the useful one over it at a time.

5 A man's prosperity is in the Lord's hand, and upon a scribe's face he will place his glory.

6 Do not be wrathful with your neighbor for every wrong, and do nothing in works of insolence.

7 Arrogance is hateful before the Lord and humans, and injustice is offensive to both.

8 A kingdom is transferred from nation to nation through injustices and insults and wealth.

9 Why are earth and ashes arrogant? Because in life I cast out his inward parts.

10 A long sickness, a physician mocks; and a king today, and tomorrow he will die.

11 For when a human dies, he will inherit creeping things and beasts and worms.

12 A beginning of human arrogance is departing from the Lord, and his heart departed from the one making him.

13 Because a beginning of arrogance is sin, and the one holding it will shower an abomination; therefore the Lord made the afflictions extraordinary, and overturned them to the end.

14 The Lord took down rulers' thrones, and seated meek ones in their place;

15 the Lord plucked out nations' roots, and planted humble ones in their place;

16 the Lord overturned nations' lands, and destroyed them to earth's foundations;

17 he removed from them and destroyed them, and caused their memorial to cease from earth.

18 Arrogance has not been created for humans, nor anger of wrath for women's offspring.

19 What seed is honored? A human's seed. What seed is honored? Those fearing the Lord. What seed is dishonored? A human's seed. What seed is dishonored? Those transgressing commandments.

20 Among brothers their leader is honored, and those fearing the Lord in his eyes.

22 Rich and glorious and poor—their boasting is fear of the Lord.

23 It is not righteous to dishonor an understanding poor man, and it is not fitting to glorify a sinful man.

24 A great man and judge and ruler will be glorified, and none of them is greater than the one fearing the Lord.

25 Free men will minister to a wise household servant, and a knowledgeable man will not grumble.

26 Do not display wisdom in doing your work, and do not be glorified in a time of your distress.

27 Better is one working and abounding in all things than one walking about glorified and lacking bread.

28 Child, in meekness glorify your soul, and give it honor according to its worth.

29 Who will justify the one sinning against his soul? And who will glorify the one dishonoring his life?

30 A poor man is glorified through his knowledge, and a rich man is glorified through his wealth.

31 The one glorified in poverty, how much more in wealth? And the one without glory in wealth, how much more in poverty?

Chapter 11

1 A humble man's wisdom will raise his head, and seat him among great men.

2 Do not praise a man in his beauty, and do not abhor a human in his appearance.

3 A bee is small among flying things, and its fruit is first among sweet things.

4 Do not boast in clothing of garments, and do not exalt yourself in a day of glory; because the Lord's works are wondrous, and his works hidden from humans.

5 Many tyrants sat upon ground, but the unsuspected one wore a diadem.

6 Many rulers were exceedingly dishonored, and glorious ones were delivered into others' hands.

7 Before you examine, do not blame; understand first, and then rebuke.

8 Before hearing, do not answer, and do not interrupt amid words.

9 Do not quarrel concerning a matter of which you have no need, and do not sit together in sinners' judgment.

10 Child, let your actions not be concerning many things; if you multiply them, you will not be acquitted; and if you pursue, you will certainly not overtake; and you will certainly not escape by running away.

11 There is one laboring and toiling and hastening, and so much more he is lacking.

12 There is a sluggish man needing help, lacking strength and abounding in poverty; and the Lord's eyes looked upon him for good things, and he raised him from his humiliation,

13 and raised his head, and many marveled at him.

14 Good things and evils, life and death, poverty and wealth are from the Lord.

17 The Lord's gift remains with the pious, and his good pleasure will prosper for the age.

18 There is one becoming rich from his attention and tightness, and this is the portion of his wage;

19 when he says, I found rest, and now I will eat of my good things, and he does not know what time will pass, and he will leave them to others and die.

20 Stand in your covenant and occupy yourself with it, and grow old in your work.

21 Do not marvel at a sinner's works, but believe the Lord and remain in your toil; because it is easy in the Lord's eyes to make a needy man rich swiftly, suddenly.

22 The Lord's blessing is in a pious man's wage, and in a swift hour he makes his blessing flourish.

23 Do not say, What is my need, and what will my good things be from now?

24 Do not say, I have sufficient things, and what harm will I suffer from now?

25 In a day of good things there is forgetfulness of evils, and in a day of evils he will not remember good things;

26 because it is easy before the Lord on a day of an end to repay a human according to his ways.

27 Affliction of an hour makes forgetfulness of luxury, and at a human's completion is a revelation of his works.

28 Before an end pronounce no one blessed, and a man will be known in his children.

29 Do not bring every human into your house; for the deceitful man's ambushes are many.

30 A hunting partridge in a basket—thus is an arrogant man's heart, and like the spy he watches a fall;

31 for turning good things into evils, he lies in wait, and upon choice things will place blame.

32 From a spark of fire a bed of coals multiplies, and a sinful human lies in wait for blood.

33 Be attentive concerning an evildoer, for he devises wicked things, lest he give you blame for the age.

34 House a stranger, and he will twist you in disturbances, and estrange you from your own things.

Chapter 12

1 If you do good, know to whom you do it, and there will be gratitude for your good things.

2 Do good to a pious man, and you will find repayment, and if not from him, then from the Most High.

3 There will be no good things for the one persisting in evils, and for the one not granting almsgiving.

4 Give to the pious man, and do not help the sinner.

5 Do good to a humble man, and do not give to an ungodly man; hinder his bread, and do not give him, so that by it he may not rule you; for you will find double evils in all good things which you may do for him.

6 Because the Most High also hated sinners, and will repay vengeance to the ungodly.

7 Give to the good man, and do not help the sinner.

8 A friend will not be avenged in good things, and an enemy will not be hidden in evils.

9 In a man's good things his enemies are in sorrow, and in his evils even the friend will separate himself.

10 Do not trust your enemy for the age; for as bronze rusts, so is his wickedness;

11 and if he is humbled and walks bent down, set your soul on guard, and guard yourself from him, and you will be to him like one polishing a mirror, and know that he has not rusted away to the end.

12 Do not stand him beside yourself, lest, overturning you, he stand in your place; do not seat him at your right, lest he seek your seat, and at the last you recognize my words, and be pierced at my utterances.

13 Who will have mercy on an enchanter bitten by a serpent, and all those approaching beasts?

14 Thus also on the one approaching a sinful man, and mingling in his sins.

15 For an hour he will remain with you, and if you turn aside, he will certainly not endure.

16 And with his lips the enemy will sweeten, and in his heart plan to overturn you into a pit; with his eyes the enemy will weep, and if he finds a time, he will not be filled with blood.

17 If evils meet you, you will find him there before you, and as though helping, he will trip your heel;

18 he will shake his head and clap his hands, and whisper many things, and alter his face.

Chapter 13

1 The one touching pitch will be defiled, and the one sharing with an arrogant man will be made like him.

2 Do not lift a weight beyond you, and do not share with one stronger and richer than you. What will an earthen pot share with a cauldron? This will strike against it, and this will be crushed.

3 A rich man did wrong, and he himself further threatened; a poor man has been wronged, and he himself will further entreat.

4 If you are useful, he works with you; and if you lack, he will leave you.

5 If you have, he will live with you and empty you, and he himself will not toil.

6 He has had need of you, and will lead you astray and smile upon you and give you hope; he will speak good things to you, and say, What is your need?

7 And he will shame you with his foods, until he empties you twice or thrice, and at the last mock you; after these things he will see you and leave you, and shake his head at you.

8 Be attentive lest you be led astray, and do not be humbled in your senselessness.

9 When a ruler calls you, become one withdrawing, and so much more he will call you;

10 do not thrust yourself in, lest you be rejected, and do not stand far away, so that you may not be forgotten.

11 Do not insist on speaking with him as an equal, and do not trust his many words; for from much speech he will test you, and as though smiling he will examine you.

12 Merciless is the one not keeping words, and he will certainly not spare concerning affliction and bonds.

13 Keep watch and attend exceedingly, because you walk with your fall.

15 Every living being loves what is like it, and every human his neighbor;

16 all flesh gathers according to kind, and a man will cling to his like.

17 What will a wolf share with a lamb? Thus is a sinner toward a pious man.

18 What peace has a hyena with a dog? And what peace has a rich man with a needy man?

19 Wild asses in a wilderness are lions' prey; thus poor men are rich men's pastures.

20 Humility is an abomination to an arrogant man; thus a poor man is an abomination to a rich man.

21 A rich man shaken is supported by friends, but a humble man fallen is further rejected by friends.

22 When a rich man stumbled, many were helpers; he spoke forbidden things, and they justified him. A humble man stumbled, and they further rebuked him; he uttered understanding, and no place was given him.

23 A rich man spoke, and all were silent, and raised his word to the clouds. A poor man spoke, and they said, Who is this? And if he stumbles, they will further overturn him.

24 Wealth is good in which there is no sin, and poverty is evil in an ungodly man's mouth.

25 A human's heart alters his face, whether for good things or for evils.

26 A trace of a heart in good things is a cheerful face, and finding parables is reasonings with toils.

Chapter 14

1 Blessed is a man who did not slip with his mouth, and was not pierced by sorrow of sins;

2 blessed is he whom his soul did not condemn, and who did not fall from his hope.

3 Wealth is not good for a petty man, and for an envious human, why wealth?

4 The one gathering at his soul's expense gathers for others, and others will live luxuriously in his good things.

5 The one evil to himself, to whom will he be good? And he will certainly not rejoice in his wealth.

6 There is none more evil than the one begrudging himself, and this is repayment of his wickedness;

7 and even if he does good, he does it in forgetfulness, and at the last discloses his wickedness.

8 Evil is the one begrudging with an eye, turning a face away and overlooking souls.

9 A greedy man's eye is not filled with a portion, and evil injustice dries up a soul.

10 An evil eye is envious over bread, and deficient at its table.

11 Child, according as you have, do good to yourself, and bring offerings to the Lord worthily;

12 remember that death will not delay, and a covenant of Hades was not shown you;

13 before you die, do good to a friend, and according to your strength stretch out and give him.

14 Do not deprive yourself of a good day, and let no portion of good desire pass you by.

15 Will you not leave your toils to another, and your labors for division of a lot?

16 Give and take and deceive your soul, because in Hades it is not possible to seek luxury.

17 All flesh grows old like a garment; for the covenant from an age is, By death you will die.

18 Like a leaf flourishing upon a leafy tree, some it casts down, but others it grows, so is a generation of flesh and blood, one dies, but another is born.

19 Every work rotting ceases, and the one working it will depart with it.

20 Blessed is a man who will meditate in wisdom, and who will converse in his understanding,

21 the one considering her ways in his heart, and he will ponder in her hidden things.

22 Go out after her like a tracker, and lie in wait in her ways.

23 The one peering through her windows, and he will listen at her doorways,

24 the one lodging near her house, and he will fix a peg in her walls,

25 will stand his tent beside her hands, and lodge in a lodging of good things,

26 will place his children in her shelter, and lodge beneath her branches,

27 will be sheltered by her from burning heat, and lodge in her glory.

Chapter 15

1 The one fearing the Lord will do it, and the one holding the law will take hold of her;

2 and she will meet him like a mother, and like a wife of virginity receive him;

3 she will feed him bread of understanding, and give him water of wisdom to drink;

4 he will be supported upon her and certainly not incline, and will rely upon her and certainly not be put to shame;

5 and she will exalt him above his neighbors, and open his mouth in the midst of an assembly;

6 he will find gladness and a crown of exultation, and inherit an everlasting name.

7 Humans without understanding will certainly not take hold of her, and sinful men will certainly not see her;

8 she is far from arrogance, and lying men will certainly not remember her.

9 Praise is not beautiful in a sinner's mouth, because it was not sent from the Lord;

10 for praise will be said in wisdom, and the Lord will prosper it.

11 Do not say that, Because of the Lord I departed; for what he hated he will not do.

12 Do not say that, He himself led me astray; for he has no need of a sinful man.

13 The Lord hated every abomination, and it is not beloved by those fearing him.

14 He himself made a human from the beginning, and left him in the hand of his counsel.

15 If you will, you will keep commandments, and to do faithfulness is of good pleasure.

16 He placed fire and water beside you; to whichever you will, you will stretch out your hand.

17 Before humans are life and death, and whatever he may delight in will be given him.

18 Because the Lord's wisdom is great; strong in dominion and seeing all things,

19 and his eyes are upon those fearing him, and he himself will recognize every human's work.

20 He commanded no one to act ungodly, and gave no one license to sin.

Chapter 16

1 Do not desire a multitude of useless children, nor rejoice over ungodly sons;

2 if they multiply, do not rejoice over them, unless fear of the Lord is with them.

3 Do not trust their life, and do not rely upon their multitude; for one is better than a thousand, and to die childless than to have ungodly children.

4 For from one understanding man a city will be populated, but a tribe of lawless men will be laid waste.

5 My eye has seen many such things, and my ear has heard stronger things than these.

6 In an assembly of sinners fire will be kindled, and in a disobedient nation anger was kindled.

7 He did not make atonement concerning the ancient giants, who departed in their strength;

8 he did not spare concerning Lot's sojourn, whom he abhorred through their arrogance;

9 he did not have mercy on a nation of destruction, those lifted up in their sins,

10 and thus six hundred thousand footmen, those gathered together in their hardness of heart.

11 And even if there is one stiff-necked man, it is wondrous if he will be acquitted; for mercy and anger are with him, a ruler of atonements and one pouring out anger.

12 According to his great mercy, so also is his reproof great; he will judge a man according to his works.

13 A sinner will not escape with plunder, and a pious man's endurance will certainly not fall behind.

14 He will make a place for every act of almsgiving; each will find according to his works.

17 Do not say that, I will be hidden from the Lord, and who will remember me from on high? Among a greater people I will certainly not be known, for what is my soul in immeasurable creation?

18 Behold, heaven and the heaven of heaven, abyss and earth will be shaken at his inspection;

19 together the mountains and earth's foundations, when he looks upon them, are shaken together with trembling.

20 And a heart will not consider these things, and who will ponder his ways?

21 And a tempest which a human will not see, and most of his works are in hidden places.

22 Who will announce works of righteousness? Or who will endure? For the covenant is far away.

23 One deficient in heart considers these things, and a senseless and wandering man considers foolish things.

24 Hear me, child, and learn knowledge, and with your heart attend to my words;

25 I will disclose discipline by weight, and announce knowledge with exactness.

26 In the Lord's judgment are his works from the beginning, and from their making he distinguished their portions.

27 He ordered his works for an age, and their beginnings for their generations; neither did they hunger nor labor, and they did not cease from their works;

28 each did not oppress his neighbor, and for an age they will not disobey his word.

29 And after these things the Lord looked upon the earth, and filled it with his good things;

30 with the soul of every living being he covered its face, and into it is their return.

Chapter 17

1 The Lord created a human from earth, and again returned him into it.

2 He gave them numbered days and a time, and gave them authority over the things upon it.

3 According to himself he clothed them with strength, and according to his image made them.

4 He placed his fear upon all flesh, and to master beasts and birds.

6 Counsel and tongue and eyes, ears and heart he gave them to consider.

7 He filled them with knowledge of understanding, and showed them good things and evils.

8 He placed his eye upon their hearts, to show them the greatness of his works,

10 and they will praise a name of sanctification, so that they may recount the great things of his works.

11 He added knowledge to them, and gave them a law of life as inheritance.

12 He established an everlasting covenant with them, and showed them his judgments.

13 Their eyes saw a greatness of glory, and their ear heard glory of his voice.

14 And he said to them, Be attentive against every injustice; and he commanded each of them concerning his neighbor.

15 Their ways are before him continually; they will not be hidden from his eyes.

17 For each nation he appointed a leader, and Israel is the Lord's portion.

19 All their works are like the sun before him, and his eyes continually upon their ways.

20 Their injustices were not hidden from him, and all their sins are before the Lord.

22 A man's almsgiving is like a seal with him, and he will keep a human's kindness like a pupil.

23 After these things he will rise up and repay them, and render their repayment upon their head;

24 yet to those repenting he gave a return, and encouraged those failing in endurance.

25 Turn to the Lord and leave sins, entreat before his face and lessen stumbling;

26 return to the Most High and turn from injustice, and exceedingly hate an abomination.

27 Who will praise the Most High in Hades instead of those living and giving thanksgiving?

28 From a dead one, as from one not even existing, confession perishes; one living and healthy will praise the Lord.

29 How great is the Lord's mercy, and atonement for those turning to him.

30 For not all things can be in humans, because a son of man is not immortal.

31 What is brighter than the sun? And even this fails; and flesh and blood will think evil.

32 He himself inspects the power of heaven's height, and all humans are earth and ashes.

Chapter 18

1 The one living for the age created all things together;

2 the Lord alone will be justified.

4 To no one did he give the ability to declare his works; and who will trace his great things?

5 Who will count the might of his majesty? And who will add to recounting his mercies?

6 It is not possible to lessen or add, and it is not possible to trace the Lord's wondrous things;

7 when a human finishes, then he begins; and when he ceases, then he will be at a loss.

8 What is a human, and what is his use? What is his good, and what his evil?

9 The number of a human's days, many years, is a hundred;

10 like a drop of water from sea and a pebble of sand, so are few years in a day of an age.

11 Therefore the Lord was long-suffering toward them, and poured his mercy upon them.

12 He saw and recognized their downfall, that it is evil; therefore he multiplied his atonement.

13 A human's mercy is upon his neighbor, but the Lord's mercy upon all flesh; reproving and disciplining and teaching and turning back, like a shepherd his flock.

14 He has mercy on those receiving discipline, and those hastening to his judgments.

15 Child, in good things do not give blame, and in every gift sorrow of words.

16 Will dew not give rest from burning heat? Thus a word is better than a gift.

17 Behold, is not a word above a good gift? And both are with a gracious man.

18 A fool will reproach ungraciously, and an envious man's gift wastes away eyes.

19 Before speaking, learn, and before sickness, be treated.

20 Before judgment examine yourself, and in an hour of inspection you will find atonement.

21 Before you become sick, be humbled, and in a time of sins show a turning back.

22 Do not be hindered from repaying a vow at a fitting time, and do not wait until death to be justified.

23 Before praying prepare yourself, and do not become like a human testing the Lord.

24 Remember wrath in days of an end, and a time of vengeance in a turning away of a face.

25 Remember a time of famine in a time of fullness, poverty and want in days of wealth.

26 From morning until evening a time changes, and all things are swift before the Lord.

27 A wise human will be wary in everything, and in days of sins will be attentive against transgression.

28 Every understanding man knew wisdom, and will give praise to the one finding her.

29 Understanding ones in words themselves also became wise, and showered exact proverbs.

30 Do not walk after your desires, and restrain yourself from your appetites;

31 if you supply your soul with the pleasure of desire, it will make you a delight of your enemies.

32 Do not rejoice over much luxury, lest you be bound to its expense.

33 Do not become poor feasting on borrowed money, and you have nothing in a purse.

Chapter 19

1 A drunken worker will not be made rich; the one despising small things will fall little by little.

2 Wine and women will make understanding ones depart, and the one clinging to prostitutes will be more reckless;

3 rot and worms will inherit him, and a reckless soul will be removed.

4 The one trusting swiftly is light in heart, and the one sinning will transgress against his soul.

5 The one rejoicing in heart will be condemned,

6 and the one hating speech is lessened in wickedness.

7 Never repeat a word, and nothing will certainly be diminished for you.

8 With friend and enemy do not recount, and unless it is sin for you, do not disclose;

9 for he has heard you and guarded himself against you, and in a time will hate you.

10 Have you heard a word? Let it die with you; be confident, it will certainly not burst you.

11 Before a word a fool will suffer birth-pains, like a woman giving birth before an infant.

12 An arrow fixed in a thigh of flesh—thus is a word in a fool's belly.

13 Reprove a friend, perhaps he did not do it, and if he did something, lest he add to it.

14 Reprove your neighbor, perhaps he did not say it, and if he has said it, so that he may not repeat it.

15 Reprove a friend, for often slander occurs, and do not believe every word.

16 There is one slipping and not from the soul, and who did not sin with his tongue?

17 Reprove your neighbor before threatening, and give place to the Most High's law.

20 All wisdom is fear of the Lord, and in all wisdom is doing law;

22 and knowledge of wickedness is not wisdom, and there is no prudence where sinners' counsel is.

23 There is cunning, and this is an abomination, and there is a senseless man deficient in wisdom;

24 better is one inferior in understanding, fearful, than one abounding in prudence and transgressing law.

25 There is exact cunning, and this is unjust, and there is one twisting a favor to disclose a judgment.

26 There is one acting wickedly, bent down in gloom, and his inward things full of deceit;

27 hiding a face and choosing to be deaf, where he was not recognized he will forestall you;

28 and if through a deficiency of strength he is hindered from sinning, if he finds a time, he will do evil.

29 A man will be recognized from appearance, and a thoughtful man recognized from the meeting of a face;

30 a man's attire and laughter of teeth and a human's steps will announce the things concerning him.

Chapter 20

1 There is a reproof which is not beautiful, and there is one silent who is himself prudent.

2 How good it is to reprove rather than be wrathful,

3 and the one confessing will be hindered from loss.

4 A eunuch's desire to deprive a young woman of virginity—thus is the one making judgments with force.

5 There is one silent found wise, and there is one hateful from much speech.

6 There is one silent, for he has no answer, and there is one silent knowing a time.

7 A wise human will be silent until a time, but the babbler and senseless man will pass beyond a time.

8 The one abounding in word will be abhorred, and the one exercising authority will be hated.

9 There is prosperity for a man in evils, and there is a finding for loss.

10 There is a gift which will not profit you, and there is a gift whose repayment is double.

11 There is a loss for glory's sake, and there is one who raised a head from humiliation.

12 There is one buying many things for little, and repaying them sevenfold.

13 The wise man in words will make himself beloved, but fools' favors will be poured away.

14 A senseless man's gift will not profit you, for his eyes are many instead of one;

15 he will give little and reproach much, and open his mouth like a herald; today he will lend and tomorrow demand back; such a human is hateful.

16 A fool will say, I have no friend, and there is no gratitude for my good things;

17 those eating his bread are base in tongue; how often and how many will laugh at him?

18 A slip from ground rather than from a tongue; thus a fall of evil ones will come swiftly.

19 An ungracious human, an untimely tale; in mouths of undisciplined ones it will persist.

20 A parable from a fool's mouth will be rejected; for he will certainly not say it in its time.

21 There is one hindered from sinning through want, and in his rest he will not be pierced.

22 There is one destroying his soul through shame, and through a senseless face he will destroy it.

23 There is one promising a friend for shame's sake, and he acquired him as an enemy for nothing.

24 A lie is an evil blemish in a human; in mouths of undisciplined ones it will persist.

25 A thief is preferable to the one persisting in a lie, but both will inherit destruction.

26 A lying human's character is dishonor, and his shame is with him continually.

27 The wise man in words will advance himself, and a prudent human will please great men.

28 The one working earth will raise his heap, and the one pleasing great men will make atonement for injustice.

29 Guest-gifts and gifts blind wise ones' eyes, and like a muzzle in a mouth turn away reproofs.

30 Hidden wisdom and an unseen treasure—what benefit is in both?

31 Better is a human hiding his foolishness than a human hiding his wisdom.

Chapter 21

1 Child, did you sin? Add no longer, and entreat concerning your former things.

2 Flee from sin as from a serpent's face; for if you approach, it will bite you; her teeth are a lion's teeth, destroying humans' souls.

3 All lawlessness is like a two-edged sword; for its wound there is no healing.

4 Terror and insolence will lay wealth waste; thus an arrogant man's house will be laid waste.

5 A poor man's entreaty is from mouth to his ears, and his judgment comes swiftly.

6 The one hating reproof is in a sinner's track, and the one fearing the Lord will turn in heart.

7 The mighty in tongue is known from afar, but the thoughtful man knows when he slips.

8 The one building his house with others' wealth is like one gathering his stones for winter.

9 An assembly of lawless men is gathered tow, and their completion a flame of fire.

10 Sinners' way is smoothed with stones, and at its last is a pit of Hades.

11 The one guarding law masters his thought, and wisdom is completion of fear of the Lord.

12 The one who is not skillful will not be disciplined, but there is cunning multiplying bitterness.

13 A wise man's knowledge will multiply like a flood, and his counsel is like a spring of life.

14 A fool's inward parts are like a broken vessel, and he will not retain any knowledge.

15 If a knowledgeable man hears a wise word, he will praise it and add to it; the prodigal heard, and it displeased him, and he turned it behind his back.

16 A fool's explanation is like a burden on a way, but grace will be found upon an understanding man's lip.

17 A prudent man's mouth will be sought in an assembly, and they will consider his words in heart.

18 As a destroyed house, so is wisdom to a fool, and an uncomprehending man's knowledge is unexamined words.

19 Discipline is fetters upon an unthinking man's feet, and like handcuffs upon a right hand.

20 A fool raises his voice in laughter, but a skillful man will scarcely smile quietly.

21 Discipline is like a golden adornment to a prudent man, and like a bracelet upon a right arm.

22 A fool's foot is swift into a house, but an experienced human will be ashamed before a face.

23 A senseless man peers from a door into a house, but a disciplined man will stand outside.

24 It is a human's lack of discipline to listen beside a door, but the prudent man will be burdened with dishonor.

25 Strangers' lips will recount these things, but prudent men's words will be weighed in a balance.

26 Their heart is in fools' mouth, but wise ones' heart is their mouth.

27 When an ungodly man curses Satan, he himself curses his own soul.

28 The whisperer defiles his own soul, and will be hated in a sojourn.

Chapter 22

1 A lazy man was compared to a soiled stone, and everyone will hiss at his dishonor.

2 A lazy man was compared to a lump of dung; everyone taking him up will shake a hand.

3 A father's shame is in begetting an undisciplined child, and a daughter comes for loss.

4 A prudent daughter will inherit her husband, and the one causing shame is for sorrow of the one begetting her;

5 the bold woman shames father and husband, and will be dishonored by both.

6 An untimely account is music in mourning, but scourges and discipline are of wisdom at every time.

9 The one teaching a fool is gluing a potsherd, awakening a sleeper from deep sleep.

10 The one recounting to a fool is recounting to one slumbering, and at completion he will say, What is it?

11 Weep over a dead one, for he lost light, and weep over a fool, for he lost understanding; weep more gladly over a dead one, because he rested, but the fool's life is worse than death.

12 Mourning for a dead one is seven days, but for a fool and ungodly man all the days of his life.

13 Do not multiply word with a senseless man, and do not go to one without understanding; guard yourself from him, so that you may not have labor, and you will certainly not be defiled in his shaking; turn away from him and you will find rest, and certainly not become weary in his folly.

14 What will be heavier than lead? And what is its name except Fool?

15 Sand and salt and a lump of iron are easier to bear than a human without understanding.

16 Wooden bracing bound into a building will not be loosened in a shaking; thus a heart established upon a thought of counsel will not become timid in a time.

17 A heart founded upon thought of understanding is like a sandy adornment of a polished wall.

18 Stakes lying on a high place will certainly not endure before wind; thus a timid heart upon a fool's thought will certainly not endure before every fear.

19 The one pricking an eye will bring down tears, and one pricking a heart discloses perception.

20 One throwing a stone at birds scares them away, and the one reproaching a friend will dissolve friendship.

21 If you draw a sword against a friend, do not despair, for there is a return;

22 if you open a mouth against a friend, do not be wary, for there is reconciliation; except reproach and arrogance and disclosure of a secret and a deceitful blow, in these every friend will flee.

23 Acquire faithfulness with your neighbor in poverty, so that you may be filled together in his good things; in a time of affliction remain with him, so that you may inherit together in his inheritance.

24 Before fire are vapor of a furnace and smoke; thus before bloodshed are revilings.

25 I will not be ashamed to shelter a friend, and will certainly not hide from his face,

26 and if evils happen to me through him, everyone hearing will guard himself from him.

27 Who will give a guard upon my mouth, and a skillful seal upon my lips, so that I may not fall through it, and my tongue destroy me?

Chapter 23

1 Lord, Father and Master of my life, do not abandon me to their counsel, do not let me fall in them.

2 Who will set scourges over my thought, and discipline of wisdom over my heart, so that they may not spare my acts of ignorance, and he will certainly not overlook their sins,

3 so that my ignorances may not multiply, and my sins abound, and I will fall before the adversaries, and my enemy rejoice over me?

4 Lord, Father and God of my life, do not give me loftiness of eyes,

5 and turn desire away from me;

6 let appetite of belly and intercourse not overtake me, and do not deliver me to a shameless soul.

7 Hear discipline of mouth, children, and the one guarding it will certainly not be caught.

8 A sinner will be caught in his lips, and a reviler and arrogant man will stumble in them.

9 Do not accustom your mouth to an oath, and do not become accustomed to naming the Holy One;

10 for just as a household servant continually examined will not be free of a bruise, so also the one swearing and naming continually will certainly not be cleansed from sin.

11 A man of many oaths will be filled with lawlessness, and a scourge will not depart from his house; if he transgresses, his sin is upon him, and if he overlooks, he sinned doubly; and if he swore vainly, he will not be justified, for his house will be filled with afflictions.

12 There is an expression comparable to death; let it not be found in Iakob's inheritance; for all these things will depart from the pious, and they will not wallow in sins.

13 Do not accustom your mouth to coarse lack of discipline; for in it is a word of sin.

14 Remember your father and mother, for you sit among great men, lest you forget before them, and become foolish through your habit, and wish that you had not been born, and curse the day of your birth.

15 A human accustomed to words of reproach will certainly not be disciplined in all his days.

16 Two kinds multiply sins, and the third will bring anger;

17 a hot soul is like burning fire, it will certainly not be extinguished until it is swallowed; a fornicating human in the body of his flesh will certainly not cease until he kindles fire; to a fornicating human every bread is sweet, he will certainly not cease until he dies.

18 A human transgressing from his bed, saying in his soul, Who sees me? Darkness is around me, and walls cover me, and no one sees me; why am I wary? The Most High will certainly not remember my sins.

19 And humans' eyes are his fear, and he did not know that the Lord's eyes are ten-thousandfold brighter than the sun, looking upon all humans' ways and observing into hidden places.

20 Before all things were created they have been known to him, so also after they were completed.

21 This man will be punished in a city's squares, and where he did not suspect, he will be seized.

22 Thus also a woman leaving her husband, and presenting an heir from a stranger.

23 For first she disobeyed in the Most High's law, and second transgressed against her husband, and third committed adultery in fornication, and presented children from a strange man.

24 She will be brought out into an assembly, and there will be an inspection upon her children.

25 Her children will not spread into a root, and her branches will not bear fruit.

26 She will leave her memorial as a curse, and her reproach will not be wiped out,

27 and those left behind will recognize that nothing is better than fear of the Lord, and nothing sweeter than attending to the Lord's commandments.

Chapter 24

1 Wisdom will praise her soul and boast in the midst of her people;

2 in the assembly of the Most High she will open her mouth and boast before his power.

3 I came forth from the mouth of the Most High and covered the earth like mist;

4 I encamped in the heights, and my throne was in a pillar of cloud;

5 I alone circled the circuit of heaven and walked in the depth of abysses;

6 in the waves of the sea and in all the earth and in every people and nation I acquired possession.

7 Among all these I sought rest, and in whose inheritance shall I lodge?

8 Then the creator of all commanded me, and he who created me gave my tent rest and said, Encamp in Iakob, and receive an inheritance in Israel.

9 Before the age, from the beginning, he created me, and until the age I shall certainly not cease.

10 In a holy tent before him I ministered, and thus I was established in Sion;

11 in a beloved city likewise he gave me rest, and in Ierusalem is my authority;

12 and I took root in a glorified people, in the Lord's portion, his inheritance.

13 Like a cedar I was raised up in Lebanon and like a cypress in the mountains of Aermon;

14 like a palm I was raised up in Aiggadois and like rose plants in Iericho, like a comely olive in a plain, and I was raised up like a plane tree.

15 Like cinnamon and aromatic aspalathus I have given a scent, and like choice myrrh I spread fragrance, like galbanum and onycha and stacte and like a vapor of frankincense in a tent.

16 I, like a terebinth, extended my branches, and my branches are branches of glory and grace.

17 I, like a vine, sprouted grace, and my blossoms are fruit of glory and wealth.

19 Come to me, you who desire me, and be filled from my produce;

20 for my remembrance is sweeter than honey, and my inheritance than a honeycomb.

21 Those eating me will still hunger, and those drinking me will still thirst.

22 He who listens to me will not be ashamed, and those working in me will not sin.

23 All these things are the book of the covenant of God Most High, a law which Moyses commanded us as an inheritance for the congregations of Iakob,

25 he who fills with wisdom like Phison and like Tigris in the days of new produce,

26 he who fills with understanding like Euphrates and like Iordanes in the days of harvest,

27 he who manifests discipline like light, like Geon in the days of vintage.

28 The first did not finish knowing her, and likewise the last did not trace her out;

29 for her thought increased from the sea, and her counsel from a great abyss.

30 And I, like a canal from a river and like a water conduit, came forth into a garden;

31 I said, I will water my garden and drench my garden bed; and behold, my canal became a river for me, and my river became a sea.

32 Still I will illuminate discipline like dawn and manifest them far away;

33 still I will pour out teaching like prophecy and leave it for generations of ages.

34 See that I have not labored for myself alone, but for all who seek her out.

Chapter 25

1 In three things I was made beautiful and stood beautiful before the Lord and human beings: concord of brothers, and friendship of neighbors, and a wife and husband accommodating themselves to one another.

2 But three kinds my soul hated, and I was greatly offended at their life: a proud poor man, and a rich liar, an old adulterer deficient in understanding.

3 In youth you have not gathered, and how could you find in your old age?

4 How beautiful is judgment for gray hairs, and for elders to know counsel.

5 How beautiful is the wisdom of old men, and thought and counsel for the honored.

6 The crown of old men is abundant experience, and their boast is fear of the Lord.

7 Nine conceptions I called blessed in heart, and the tenth I will speak upon my tongue: a person rejoicing over children, living and looking upon the fall of enemies;

8 blessed is he who lives with an understanding wife, and he who did not slip with his tongue, and he who did not serve one unworthy of himself;

9 blessed is he who found prudence, and he who recounts to the ears of listeners;

10 how great is he who found wisdom; but he is not above him who fears the Lord;

11 fear of the Lord surpassed everything; he who holds it, to whom will he be likened?

13 Every wound, but not a wound of the heart, and every wickedness, but not the wickedness of a woman;

14 every affliction, but not an affliction from those who hate, and every vengeance, but not the vengeance of enemies.

15 There is no head above the head of a snake, and there is no fury above the fury of an enemy.

16 I will prefer to live with a lion and a dragon rather than live with a wicked woman.

17 A woman's wickedness alters her appearance and darkens her face like a bear;

18 in the midst of his neighbors her husband will recline, and unwillingly he sighed bitterly.

19 Every evil is small compared with a woman's evil; may a sinner's lot fall upon her.

20 A sandy ascent beneath an elder's feet, so is a talkative woman to a quiet man.

21 Do not fall for a woman's beauty, and do not long for a woman.

22 Wrath and shamelessness and great shame, if a woman provides for her husband.

23 A humbled heart and a gloomy face and a wound of the heart are a wicked woman; slack hands and paralyzed knees is she who will not make her husband blessed.

24 From a woman is the beginning of sin, and because of her we all die.

25 Do not give water an outlet, nor a wicked woman freedom of speech;

26 if she does not walk according to your hands, cut her off from your flesh.

Chapter 26

1 Blessed is the husband of a good wife, and the number of his days is double.

2 A courageous wife gladdens her husband, and he will fulfill his years in peace.

3 A good wife is a good portion; in the portion of those fearing the Lord she will be given;

4 and the heart of rich and poor is good, at every time a cheerful face.

5 At three things my heart was apprehensive, and at the fourth appearance I made supplication: slander of a city, and an assembly of a mob, and a false accusation, all grievous beyond death.

6 Pain of heart and mourning is a woman jealous of a woman, and a scourge of the tongue communicating with everyone.

7 A shaking ox yoke is a wicked woman; he who holds her is like one grasping a scorpion.

8 Great wrath is a drunken woman, and she will not conceal her indecency.

9 A woman's prostitution will be known in the raising of her eyes and in her eyelids.

10 Over an unrestrained daughter strengthen your guard, lest, finding freedom, she use it for herself;

11 guard against a shameless eye, and do not marvel if she transgresses against you;

12 like a thirsty traveler she will open her mouth and drink from every nearby water; opposite every stake she will sit, and before an arrow she will open a quiver.

13 A woman's grace will delight her husband, and her knowledge will fatten his bones.

14 A gift of the Lord is a silent woman, and there is no exchange for a disciplined soul;

15 grace upon grace is a modest woman, and no weight is worthy of a self-controlled soul.

16 The sun rising in the Lord's heights, and the beauty of a good woman in the adornment of her house;

17 a lamp shining upon a holy lampstand, and the beauty of a face upon a mature stature;

18 golden pillars upon a silver base, and beautiful feet upon the breasts of a steadfast one.

28 At two things my heart has been grieved, and at the third fury came upon me: a warrior lacking because of want, and understanding men if they are treated as refuse, one turning back from righteousness to sin; the Lord will prepare him for a sword.

29 A merchant will scarcely be delivered from transgression, and a retailer will not be justified from sin.

Chapter 27

1 For the sake of profit many sinned, and he who seeks to increase will turn away an eye.

2 Between the joints of stones a stake will be fixed, and between selling and buying sin will be crushed in.

3 If he does not hold firmly in fear of the Lord with diligence, his house will quickly be overthrown.

4 In the shaking of a sieve dung remains, so a person's refuse in his reasoning.

5 A furnace tests a potter's vessels, and a person's testing is in his deliberation.

6 The cultivation of a tree its fruit manifests, so does speech the thought of a person's heart.

7 Before reasoning do not praise a man; for this is the testing of human beings.

8 If you pursue what is just, you will attain it and put it on like a robe of glory reaching to the feet.

9 Birds will lodge with their like, and truth will return to those who work it.

10 A lion lies in ambush for prey, so does sin for those working unjust things.

11 A pious person's discourse is wisdom continually, but the senseless changes like the moon.

12 Among those without understanding observe the time, but among thoughtful people stay continually.

13 The discourse of fools is an offense, and their laughter is in the luxury of sin.

14 The talk of one swearing many oaths will make hairs stand up, and their quarrel is a stopping of ears.

15 A quarrel of the proud is bloodshed, and their mutual abuse is a grievous hearing.

16 He who reveals secrets destroyed trust and will certainly not find a friend for his soul.

17 Cherish a friend and be faithful with him; but if you reveal his secrets, do not pursue after him.

18 For just as a person lost his dead one, so you lost your neighbor's friendship;

19 and as you released a bird from your hand, so you let your neighbor go and will not catch him.

20 Do not pursue him, because he departed far away and escaped like a gazelle from a snare.

21 For a wound can be bound, and for abuse there is reconciliation, but he who revealed secrets has given up hope.

22 He who winks with an eye devises evils, and no one will remove them from him;

23 before your eyes he will sweeten his mouth and marvel at your words, but afterward he will twist his mouth and put a stumbling block in your words.

24 Many things I hated, and I did not liken them to him, and the Lord will hate him.

25 He who throws a stone upward throws upon his own head, and a deceitful blow will make wounds.

26 He who digs a pit will fall into it, and he who sets a snare will be caught in it.

27 He who does wicked things, they will roll upon him, and he will certainly not know from where it comes to him.

28 Mockery and reproach are for a proud person, and vengeance like a lion will lie in ambush for him.

29 Those rejoicing at the fall of the pious will be caught in a snare, and pain will consume them before their death.

30 Resentment and wrath, these too are abominations, and a sinful man will possess them.

Chapter 28

1 He who takes vengeance will find vengeance from the Lord, and he will surely keep his sins in remembrance.

2 Forgive your neighbor's wrongdoing, and then, when you make supplication, your sins will be loosed.

3 A person maintains wrath against a person, and seeks healing from the Lord?

4 He has no mercy upon a person like himself, and makes supplication concerning his sins?

5 He himself, being flesh, keeps resentment; who will make atonement for his sins?

6 Remember the last things and cease being hostile, corruption and death, and abide in commandments.

7 Remember commandments and do not bear resentment toward your neighbor, and the covenant of the Most High, and overlook ignorance.

8 Abstain from a quarrel, and you will diminish sins; for a wrathful person will kindle a quarrel,

9 and a sinful man will trouble friends and throw slander among those at peace.

10 According to the fuel of the fire, so it will be kindled, and according to the strength of the quarrel it will be kindled; according to a person's strength his fury will be, and according to his wealth he will heighten his wrath.

11 Strife being hurried on kindles fire, and a quarrel hurrying on pours out blood.

12 If you blow into a spark, it will be kindled, and if you spit upon it, it will be extinguished; and both proceed from your mouth.

13 Curse a whisperer and a double-tongued person; for he destroyed many who were at peace.

14 A third tongue shook many and dispersed them from nation to nation and demolished fortified cities and overthrew houses of great men.

15 A third tongue cast out courageous women and deprived them of their labors.

16 He who attends to it will certainly not find rest, nor encamp with quietness.

17 A blow of a whip makes a bruise, but a blow of a tongue will shatter bones.

18 Many fell by the mouth of a sword, but not as many as those who have fallen through a tongue.

19 Blessed is he who was sheltered from it, who did not pass through its fury, who did not pull its yoke and was not bound in its bonds;

20 for its yoke is an iron yoke, and its bonds are bronze bonds;

21 an evil death is its death, and Hades is more profitable than it.

22 It will certainly not take hold of the pious, and in its flame they will not be burned.

23 Those abandoning the Lord will fall into it, and among them it will be kindled and certainly not be extinguished; it will be sent against them like a lion and ravage them like a leopard.

24 See, fence your possession around with thorns; bind up your silver and your gold;

25 and for your words make a balance and a weight, and for your mouth make a door and a bar.

26 Beware lest you slip by it, lest you fall before one lying in ambush.

Chapter 29

1 He who does mercy will lend to his neighbor, and he who strengthens with his hand keeps commandments.

2 Lend to your neighbor in the time of his need, and repay your neighbor at the time;

3 Establish your word and be faithful with him, and at every time you will find what you need.

4 Many considered a loan as a windfall and provided trouble for those who helped them.

5 Until he receives, he will kiss his hands and lower his voice over his neighbor's money; and at the time of repayment he will prolong the time and repay words of indifference and blame the time.

6 If he prevails, he will scarcely recover half and reckon it as a windfall; but if not, he deprived him of his money and acquired him as an enemy without cause; curses and abuses he will repay him, and instead of honor he will repay him dishonor.

7 Many turned away, not for the sake of wickedness; they were apprehensive of being deprived without cause.

8 Nevertheless, be patient with a lowly person, and over almsgiving do not put him off.

9 For the sake of the commandment help a needy person, and according to his want do not turn him away empty.

10 Lose silver for a brother and friend, and let it not rust beneath the stone to destruction.

11 Place your treasure according to the commandments of the Most High, and it will profit you more than gold.

12 Shut up almsgiving in your store chambers, and it will deliver you from every affliction;

13 beyond a shield of strength and beyond a spear of weight it will fight for you before an enemy.

14 A good man will become surety for his neighbor, and he who has lost shame will abandon him.

15 Do not forget a surety's favors; for he gave his soul for you.

16 A sinner will overturn a surety's good things, and one ungrateful in mind will abandon his rescuer.

17 Surety destroyed many who were prospering and shook them like a wave of the sea;

18 it displaced powerful men, and they wandered among foreign nations.

19 A sinner falling into surety and pursuing contracts will fall into judgments.

20 Help your neighbor according to your ability, and take heed to yourself lest you fall.

21 The beginning of life is water and bread and clothing and a house covering indecency.

22 Better is a poor person's life beneath a shelter of beams than splendid foods among strangers.

23 With little and much have contentment, and you will certainly not hear the reproach of sojourning.

24 An evil life is from house to house, and where you sojourn you will not open your mouth;

25 you will entertain and give drink without thanks, and in addition to these you will hear bitter things:

26 Come along, sojourner, adorn a table, and if anything is in your hand, feed me;

27 go out, sojourner, from before honor; my brother has come to stay with me, there is need of the house.

28 These things are heavy for a person having prudence, rebuke concerning lodging and reproach from a lender.

Chapter 30

1 He who loves his son will apply whips to him continually, that he may rejoice at his latter end;

2 he who disciplines his son will benefit from him and boast of him among acquaintances;

3 he who teaches his son will provoke his enemy to jealousy and exult over him before friends.

4 His father died, and as though he did not die; for he left one like himself after him.

5 In his life he saw and rejoiced, and at his death he was not grieved;

6 before enemies he left an avenger, and for friends one repaying favor.

7 He who pampers a son will bind up his wounds, and at every cry his inward parts will be troubled.

8 An untamed horse turns out obstinate, and an unrestrained son turns out headlong.

9 Nurse a child, and he will alarm you; play with him, and he will grieve you.

10 Do not laugh with him, lest you suffer pain with him, and at the last you will gnash your teeth.

11 Do not give him authority in youth;

12 bruise his sides while he is an infant, lest, becoming obstinate, he disobey you.

13 Discipline your son and labor upon him, that you may not stumble in his indecency.

14 Better is a poor person healthy and strong in constitution than a rich person scourged in his body.

15 Health and good condition are better than all gold, and a vigorous body than immeasurable prosperity.

16 There is no wealth better than bodily health, and there is no gladness above joy of heart.

17 Better is death than bitter life, and rest of an age than abiding sickness.

18 Good things poured out upon a closed mouth are offerings of foods laid beside a grave.

19 What does an offering benefit an idol? For it will neither eat nor smell; so is he who is driven out by the Lord.

20 Looking with eyes and sighing, just like a eunuch embracing a virgin and sighing.

21 Do not give your soul to grief, and do not afflict yourself in your counsel.

22 Gladness of heart is a person's life, and a man's exultation is length of days.

23 Deceive your soul and comfort your heart and remove grief far from you; for grief destroyed many, and there is no benefit in it.

24 Jealousy and fury diminish days, and care brings old age before its time.

25 A cheerful and good heart will attend to the dishes of its foods.

Chapter 31

1 Wakefulness over wealth wastes flesh, and care for it removes sleep.

2 Care of wakefulness will remove drowsiness, and a heavy sickness will sober sleep away.

3 A rich person labored in gathering money, and at rest is filled with his luxuries.

4 A poor person labored in the diminution of livelihood, and at rest becomes needy.

5 He who loves gold will not be justified, and he who pursues profits will be led astray by them.

6 Many were given over to a fall for the sake of gold, and their destruction came before their face.

7 It is a wood of stumbling for those enraptured by it, and every senseless person will be caught in it.

8 Blessed is a rich person who was found blameless and who did not go after gold;

9 who is he? And we will call him blessed; for he did wondrous things among his people.

10 Who was tested by it and perfected? And it will be a boast for him. Who could transgress and did not transgress, and do evils and did not do them?

11 His good things will be established, and an assembly will recount his almsgiving.

12 Have you sat at a great table? Do not open your throat over it and do not say, Many indeed are the things upon it;

13 remember that an evil eye is an evil. What has been created more evil than an eye? For this reason it weeps from every face.

14 Wherever it looks, do not stretch out a hand and do not jostle with it in a dish.

15 Understand your neighbor's things from yourself, and consider every matter.

16 Eat like a human being the things set beside you, and do not chew greedily, lest you be hated.

17 Cease first for the sake of discipline, and do not be insatiable, lest you stumble;

18 and if you have sat among many, do not stretch out your hand before them.

19 How sufficient for a disciplined person is a little, and upon his bed he does not pant.

20 Healthy sleep is upon a moderate gut; he rose early, and his soul was with him. Pain of wakefulness and cholera and colic are with an insatiable man;

21 and if you were forced with foods, rise, vomit far away, and you will rest.

22 Hear me, child, and do not despise me, and at the last you will find my words; in all your works become skillful, and no sickness will certainly meet you.

23 Lips will bless one generous with bread, and the testimony of his goodness is faithful.

24 A city will grumble against one wicked with bread, and the testimony of his wickedness is exact.

25 Do not show yourself a man with wine; for wine destroyed many.

26 A furnace tests steel in tempering, so does wine hearts in the quarrel of the proud.

27 Wine is equal to life for human beings, if you drink it in its measure. What life is there for one deprived of wine? And it was created for gladness for human beings.

28 Exultation of heart and gladness of soul is wine drunk at its time in sufficient measure;

29 bitterness of soul is much wine drunk in irritation and conflict.

30 Drunkenness increases a senseless person's fury to stumbling, diminishing strength and adding wounds.

31 At a drinking party of wine do not reprove your neighbor and do not despise him in his gladness; do not speak a word of reproach to him and do not afflict him with a demand.

Chapter 32

1 Did they appoint you leader? Do not exalt yourself; be among them as one of them, care for them and thus sit down;

2 and having performed all your service, recline, that you may rejoice because of them and receive a crown for good order.

3 Speak, elder, for it befits you, with exact knowledge, and do not hinder musical performances.

4 Where there is a performance, do not pour out talk, and do not show wisdom untimely.

5 A carbuncle seal upon a gold ornament is a concert of musicians at a drinking party of wine;

6 in a gold setting an emerald seal is a melody of musicians over pleasant wine.

7 Speak, young man, if there is need of you, scarcely twice if you are asked;

8 sum up your speech, many things in a few; be as one knowing and at the same time silent.

9 In the midst of great men do not make yourself equal, and while another speaks do not chatter much.

10 Before thunder lightning hastens, and before a modest person grace will go forth.

11 At the hour rise and do not lag behind; run off home and do not be sluggish;

12 there play and do your intended things, and do not sin with a proud word.

13 And over these things bless him who made you and drenches you from his good things.

14 He who fears the Lord will accept discipline, and those rising early will find favor.

15 He who seeks the law will be filled with it, and he who acts hypocritically will stumble in it.

16 Those fearing the Lord will find judgment and kindle ordinances like light.

17 A sinful person will avoid reproof and find a decision according to his wish.

18 A man of counsel will certainly not overlook a thought; a stranger and a proud person will not cower in fear.

19 Without counsel do nothing, and when you have done it do not regret it.

20 Do not walk on a way of stumbling, and do not stumble on stony places.

21 Do not trust in an unobstructed way

22 and guard against your children.

23 In every work trust your soul; for this too is keeping commandments.

24 He who trusts the law attends to commandments, and he who has trusted the Lord will not be diminished.

Chapter 33

1 No evil will meet him who fears the Lord, but in testing he will again be delivered.

2 A wise man will not hate the law, but he who acts hypocritically in it is like a ship in a storm.

3 An understanding person will trust the law, and the law is faithful to him like an inquiry of manifestations.

4 Prepare speech and thus you will be heard; bind together discipline and answer.

5 A wagon wheel is a fool's inward parts, and his deliberation is like a turning axle.

6 A horse for mating is like a mocking friend; beneath everyone sitting upon it it neighs.

7 Why does a day surpass a day, when all the light of a day of the year is from the sun?

8 By the Lord's knowledge they were separated, and he varied seasons and festivals;

9 some of them he exalted and sanctified, and some of them he placed among the number of days.

10 And all human beings are from the ground, and Adam was created from earth;

11 in an abundance of knowledge the Lord separated them and varied their ways;

12 some of them he blessed and exalted, and some of them he sanctified and brought near himself; some of them he cursed and humbled and overturned them from their station.

13 As a potter's clay in his hand – all his ways according to his pleasure – , so are human beings in the hand of him who made them, to repay them according to his judgment.

14 Opposite evil is good, and opposite death is life, so opposite a pious person is a sinner;

15 and thus look into all the works of the Most High, two by two, one opposite the other.

16 And I, last, kept watch like one gleaning after grape gatherers;

17 in the Lord's blessing I came before, and like a grape gatherer I filled a winepress.

18 Consider that I have not labored for myself alone, but for all who seek discipline.

19 Hear me, great men of the people, and leaders of the assembly, give ear.

20 To son and wife, brother and friend, do not give authority over you in your life; and do not give another your money, lest, regretting it, you make supplication for it.

21 While you still live and breath is in you, do not exchange yourself with any flesh;

22 for it is better for your children to make supplication to you than for you to look into your sons' hands.

23 In all your works be preeminent; do not put a blemish on your honor.

24 On the day of the completion of the days of your life and at the time of death distribute an inheritance.

25 Fodder and rod and loads for a donkey, bread and discipline and work for a household servant.

26 Work with a servant, and you will find rest; relax your hands toward him, and he will seek freedom.

27 A yoke and a strap will bend a neck, and for a maleficent household servant there are racks and tortures;

28 put him to work, that he may not be idle, for idleness taught much evil;

29 set him to works as befits him, and if he does not obey, make his fetters heavy.

30 And do not be excessive toward any flesh, and without judgment do nothing.

31 If you have a household servant, let him be as you, because with blood you acquired him;

32 if you have a household servant, treat him as a brother, because you will need him as your soul;

33 if you ill-treat him and, departing, he runs away, on what road will you seek him?

Chapter 34

1 Empty and false hopes are for a man without understanding, and dreams give wings to the senseless.

2 Like one grasping a shadow and pursuing wind, so is he who attends to dreams;

3 this against that is a vision of dreams, a likeness of a face opposite a face.

4 From an unclean thing what will be cleansed? And from a false thing what will be true?

5 Divinations and omens and dreams are vain, and the heart imagines like that of a woman in labor;

6 if it is not sent from the Most High in an inspection, do not give your heart to them;

7 for dreams led many astray, and they fell away while hoping in them.

8 Without falsehood the law will be accomplished, and wisdom is perfection in a faithful mouth.

9 A man who has wandered knew many things, and one of abundant experience will recount understanding;

10 he who was not tested knows few things, but he who has wandered will increase skillfulness.

11 I have seen many things in my wandering, and my understanding is more than my words;

12 many times I was endangered as far as death, and I was preserved because of these things.

13 The spirit of those fearing the Lord will live; for their hope is upon him who saves them.

14 He who fears the Lord will be apprehensive of nothing and will certainly not be cowardly, because he is his hope.

15 Blessed is the soul of him who fears the Lord; to whom does he attend? And who is his support?

16 The Lord's eyes are upon those who love him, a shield of might and a support of strength, shelter from scorching heat and shelter from midday, protection from stumbling and help against falling,

17 raising the soul and illuminating eyes, giving healing, life and blessing.

18 One sacrificing from injustice, a blemished offering, and gifts of the lawless are not for favor.

19 The Most High does not take pleasure in offerings of the ungodly, nor by a multitude of sacrifices does he make atonement for sins.

20 One slaughtering a son before his father is he who brings a sacrifice from the money of the needy.

21 The bread of the needy is the life of the poor; he who deprives them of it is a person of blood.

22 He who takes away livelihood murders his neighbor, and he who withholds a hired worker's wage pours out blood.

23 One building and one demolishing; what did they benefit beyond labors?

24 One praying and one cursing; whose voice will the Master listen to?

25 One washing from a dead person and again touching him, what did he benefit in his bathing?

26 So is a person fasting over his sins and again going and doing the same things; who will listen to his prayer? And what did he benefit in being humbled?

Chapter 35

1 He who keeps the law increases offerings; he who attends to commandments sacrifices a salvation offering.

2 One repaying favor offers fine flour, and he who does almsgiving sacrifices a praise offering.

3 The Lord's pleasure is to depart from wickedness, and atonement is to depart from injustice.

4 Do not appear before the Lord empty; for all these things are for the sake of the commandment.

5 A righteous person's offering fattens an altar, and its fragrance is before the Most High.

6 A righteous man's sacrifice is acceptable, and its remembrance will not be forgotten.

7 With a good eye glorify the Lord, and do not diminish the firstfruit of your hands.

8 In every gift make your face cheerful, and in gladness sanctify a tenth.

9 Give to the Most High according to his gift and with a good eye according to what your hand finds;

10 because the Lord is one who repays, and he will repay you sevenfold.

11 Do not bribe, for he will not accept, and do not attend to an unjust sacrifice;

12 because the Lord is a judge, and with him there is no regard for a person's honor.

13 He will not show partiality against a poor person and will listen to the supplication of one wronged;

14 he will certainly not overlook an orphan's petition and a widow if she pours out speech;

15 do not a widow's tears descend upon her cheek, and the cry against him who brought them down?

16 He who serves with good will will be accepted, and his supplication will reach as far as clouds;

17 a lowly person's prayer passed through clouds, and until it draws near he will certainly not be comforted;

18 and he will certainly not withdraw until the Most High inspects, and he will judge for the righteous and execute judgment.

19 And the Lord will certainly not delay, nor will he be patient with them,

20 until he crushes the loins of the merciless and repays vengeance to the nations,

21 until he removes the multitude of the insolent and shatters the scepters of the unjust,

22 until he repays a person according to his actions and the works of human beings according to their thoughts,

23 until he judges his people's case and gladdens them in his mercy.

24 Beautiful is mercy at the time of his affliction, like rain clouds at a time of drought.

Chapter 36

1 Have mercy on us, Master, God of all, and look upon us and put your fear upon all the nations;

2 raise your hand against foreign nations, and let them see your might.

3 Just as before them you were sanctified among us, so before us may you be magnified among them;

4 and let them know you, just as we too knew that there is no God except you, Lord.

5 Renew signs and vary wonders, glorify your hand and right arm;

6 rouse fury and pour out wrath, remove an adversary and wipe out an enemy.

7 Hasten the time and remember the oath, and let them recount your great deeds.

8 In wrath of fire let the survivor be devoured, and may those afflicting your people find destruction.

9 Shatter the heads of hostile rulers who say, There is none except us.

10 Gather all the tribes of Iakob and give them an inheritance as from the beginning.

11 Have mercy, Lord, on a people called by your name and Israel, whom you likened to a firstborn.

12 Have pity on the city of your sanctuary, Ierusalem, the place of your rest;

13 fill Sion with the recounting of your virtues, and your people from your glory.

14 Give testimony to your creatures in the beginning, and raise up prophecies in your name;

15 give a reward to those awaiting you, and let your prophets be found trustworthy.

16 Listen, Lord, to the supplication of your petitioners according to Aaron's blessing concerning your people,

17 and all those upon the earth will know that you are the Lord, the God of the ages.

18 A belly will eat every food, but there is food better than food.

19 A throat tastes foods of the hunt, so an understanding heart false words.

20 A twisted heart will give grief, and a person of abundant experience will repay him.

21 A woman will accept every male, but there is a daughter better than a daughter.

22 A woman's beauty makes a face cheerful and surpasses every human desire;

23 if mercy and gentleness are upon her tongue, her husband is not like sons of human beings.

24 He who acquires a wife begins a possession, a helper corresponding to him and a pillar of rest.

25 Where there is no fence, a possession will be plundered; and where there is no wife, he will sigh as he wanders.

26 For who will trust a readily equipped robber leaping from city to city?

27 So with a person not having a nest and lodging wherever evening overtakes him.

Chapter 37

1 Every friend will say, I too have befriended; but there is a friend who is a friend in name alone.

2 Is there not grief even to death in a companion and friend turning into enmity?

3 O wicked thought, from where were you rolled in to cover the dry land with deceit?

4 A companion enjoys a friend's gladness, and at a time of affliction will be opposite him;

5 a companion labors with a friend for the sake of his belly; before war he will take a shield.

6 Do not forget a friend in your soul, and do not fail to remember him in your wealth.

7 Every counselor extols counsel, but there is one counseling for himself.

8 Guard your soul against a counselor, and know first what his need is – for he too will counsel for himself – , lest he cast a lot against you

9 and say to you, Your way is good, and stand on the opposite side to see what will happen to you.

10 Do not take counsel with him who looks askance at you, and hide counsel from those who envy you,

11 with a woman about her rival and with a coward about war, with a merchant about exchange and with a buyer about selling, with a grudging person about thankfulness and with a merciless person about kindness, with a sluggard about any work and with an annual hired worker about completion, with an idle household servant about much work; do not attend to these for any counsel;

12 but remain continually with a pious man whom you know to keep commandments, who in his soul is according to your soul, and if you stumble, he will suffer pain with you.

13 And establish counsel of heart, for there is none more faithful to you than it;

14 for a man's soul has sometimes been accustomed to report more than seven watchers sitting on a height at a lookout.

15 And over all these things make supplication to the Most High, that he may direct your way in truth.

16 The beginning of every work is a word, and before every action is counsel.

17 A trace of change of heart causes four parts to spring up,

18 good and evil, life and death, and that which continually rules them is a tongue.

19 There is a skillful man, an instructor of many, and for his own soul he is useless.

20 There is one showing wisdom in words who is hated; this one will lack all food;

21 for grace was not given him from the Lord, because he was deprived of all wisdom.

22 There is one wise for his own soul, and the fruits of his understanding are faithful upon his mouth.

23 A wise man will discipline his own people, and the fruits of his understanding are faithful.

24 A wise man will be filled with blessing, and all who see will call him blessed.

25 A man's life is in a number of days, and the days of Israel are without number.

26 The wise will inherit trust among his people, and his name will live into the age.

27 Child, in your life test your soul, and see what is evil for it and do not give it that;

28 for not all things benefit all, and not every soul takes pleasure in everything.

29 Do not be insatiable in every luxury, and do not pour yourself out upon dishes;

30 for in many foods there will be disease, and insatiability will draw near as far as cholera;

31 through insatiability many died, but he who takes heed will add life.

Chapter 38

1 Honor a physician according to his services with his honors, for the Lord created him too;

2 for healing is from the Most High, and from a king he will receive a gift.

3 A physician's knowledge will raise his head, and before great men he will be admired.

4 The Lord created medicines from earth, and a prudent man will not be offended at them.

5 Was water not sweetened by wood, that his strength might be known?

6 And he gave human beings knowledge, to be glorified in his wonders;

7 with them he healed and removed his pain; a perfumer will make a mixture with these,

8 and his works will certainly not be finished, and peace from him is upon the face of the earth.

9 Child, in your sickness do not be neglectful, but pray to the Lord, and he will heal you;

10 remove transgression and straighten your hands and cleanse your heart from every sin;

11 give fragrance and a memorial of fine flour, and fatten an offering as one who does not exist.

12 And give a physician a place, for the Lord created him too, and let him not depart from you, for there is need of him too.

13 There is a time when success too is in their hands;

14 for they too will make supplication to the Lord, that he may grant them success in rest and healing for the sake of livelihood.

15 May he who sins before him who made him fall into a physician's hands.

16 Child, over a dead person bring down tears, and as one suffering terrible things begin a lament; and according to his due wrap up his body and do not overlook his burial.

17 Make weeping bitter and mourning fervent, and perform the mourning according to his worth, one day and two, for the sake of slander, and be comforted because of grief;

18 for from grief death comes forth, and grief of heart will bend strength.

19 In affliction grief too remains, and a poor person's life is against the heart.

20 Do not give your heart to grief; remove it, remembering the last things;

21 do not forget, for there is no return, and you will not benefit this one, and you will harm yourself.

22 Remember my judgment, because yours too is so; yesterday for me and today for you.

23 At a dead person's rest give rest to his remembrance, and be comforted concerning him at the departure of his spirit.

24 A scribe's wisdom is in the opportunity of leisure, and he who is lessened in his business will become wise.

25 How will he become wise who holds a plow and boasts in the shaft of a goad, driving oxen and occupied with their works, and whose discourse is about sons of bulls?

26 He will give his heart to producing furrows, and his wakefulness is for fodder for heifers.

27 So is every artisan and master artisan, who passes night as day; those engraving engravings of seals, and his persistence is to vary the design; he will give his heart to making a painting resemble, and his wakefulness is to finish a work.

28 So is a smith sitting near an anvil and studying works of iron; vapor of fire will melt his flesh, and in the heat of a furnace he will struggle; to the sound of a hammer he will incline his ear, and opposite the likeness of a vessel are his eyes; he will give his heart to completing works, and his wakefulness is to adorn at completion.

29 So is a potter sitting at his work and turning a wheel with his feet, who continually lies in care over his work, and all his labor is by number;

30 with his arm he will shape clay, and before his feet he will bend his strength; he will give his heart to finishing the glaze, and his wakefulness is to clean a furnace.

31 All these trusted in their hands, and each shows wisdom in his work;

32 without them a city will not be inhabited, and they will not sojourn or walk about.

33 But for a council of the people they will not be sought, and in an assembly they will not leap forward; on a judge's seat they will not sit, and a covenant of judgment they will not consider.

34 Nor will they manifest discipline and judgment, and in parables they will not be found, but they will support the creation of an age, and their supplication is in the work of their craft.

Chapter 39

1 Except for him who gives his soul and considers the law of the Most High, he will seek out the wisdom of all the ancients and be occupied with prophecies,

2 he will preserve the discourse of renowned men and enter together into the turns of parables,

3 he will seek out hidden things of proverbs and be occupied with riddles of parables.

4 Among great men he will serve and before leaders he will appear; in the land of foreign nations he will pass, for he tested good and evil things among human beings.

5 He will give his heart to rising early toward the Lord who made him and make supplication before the Most High; and he will open his mouth in prayer and make supplication concerning his sins.

6 If the great Lord wills, he will be filled with a spirit of understanding; he will rain down utterances of his wisdom and in prayer confess to the Lord;

7 he will direct his counsel and knowledge and consider his hidden things;

8 he will manifest the discipline of his teaching and boast in the law of the Lord's covenant.

9 Many will praise his understanding, and until the age it will not be erased; his remembrance will not depart, and his name will live for generations of generations;

10 nations will recount his wisdom, and an assembly will proclaim his praise;

11 if he remains, he will leave a name greater than a thousand, and if he rests, he makes it for himself.

12 Still, having considered, I will recount, and like the full moon I was filled.

13 Listen to me, holy sons, and sprout like a rose growing by a stream of water

14 and like frankincense give a fragrant scent and blossom a blossom like a lily. Spread a scent and praise with a song, bless the Lord over all the works,

15 give greatness to his name and confess in his praise with songs of lips and with lyres, and thus you will say in confession:

16 All the works of the Lord are exceedingly good, and every command will be in its time; one cannot say, What is this? For what is this? For all things will be sought in their time.

17 At his word water stood like a heap, and at the utterance of his mouth reservoirs of waters.

18 In his command is all pleasure, and there is none who will diminish his salvation.

19 The works of all flesh are before him, and one cannot be hidden from his eyes;

20 from the age to the age he looked, and nothing is wondrous before him.

21 One cannot say, What is this? For what is this? For all things have been created for their uses.

22 His blessing covered like a river and drenched dry land like a flood;

23 so nations will inherit his wrath, as he turned waters into brine.

24 His ways are straight for the holy, so for the lawless stumbling blocks;

25 good things have been created for the good from the beginning, so for sinners evil things.

26 The beginning of every need for a person's life: water and fire and iron and salt and fine wheat flour and milk and honey, blood of a grape and oil and clothing;

27 all these are for good things for the pious, so for sinners they will turn into evil things.

28 There are spirits which have been created for vengeance, and in his fury he strengthened their scourges; at the time of completion they will pour out strength and abate the fury of him who made them.

29 Fire and hail and famine and death, all these have been created for vengeance;

30 teeth of beasts and scorpions and vipers and a sword avenging the ungodly to destruction;

31 in his command they will rejoice, and upon the earth they will be prepared for uses, and in their times they will not transgress a word.

32 For this reason from the beginning I was established and considered and left in writing:

33 All the works of the Lord are good, and he will supply every need in its hour,

34 and one cannot say, This is more evil than that, for all things will be approved in their time.

35 And now with all heart and mouth sing hymns and bless the Lord's name.

Chapter 40

1 Great occupation has been created for every person, and a heavy yoke upon the sons of Adam from the day of departure from their mother's womb until the day of return to the mother of all;

2 their deliberations and fear of heart, thought of expectation, the day of death.

3 From one sitting upon a glorious throne even to one humbled in earth and ashes,

4 from one wearing violet and a crown even to one clothed in raw linen, fury and jealousy and trouble and tumult and fear of death and resentment and strife.

5 And at the time of rest upon a bed, sleep of night alters his knowledge;

6 a little, as nothing, in rest, and after that in dreams, as on a day of watching, troubled in the vision of his heart, as one who has escaped from before war;

7 at the time of his need he awoke, and was astonished at no fear.

8 With all flesh, from human being to beast, and upon sinners sevenfold beyond these;

9 death and blood and strife and sword, afflictions, famine and crushing and scourge.

10 Against the lawless all these were created, and because of them the flood occurred.

11 All things which are from earth return to earth, and those from waters turn back to the sea.

12 Every gift and injustice will be erased, and faithfulness will stand into the age.

13 The money of the unjust will dry up like a river and resound like great thunder in rain;

14 when he opens hands he will rejoice; so those transgressing will cease utterly.

15 Offspring of the ungodly will not multiply branches, and unclean roots are upon a sheer rock;

16 reed grass beside every water and river bank will be plucked out before every grass.

17 Grace is like a garden amid blessings, and almsgiving will remain into the age.

18 The life of a self-sufficient person and a worker will be sweetened, and above both is he who finds a treasure.

19 Children and building a city establish a name, and above both a blameless wife is reckoned.

20 Wine and music gladden a heart, and above both is love of wisdom.

21 A flute and a harp sweeten melodies, and above both is a pleasant tongue.

22 An eye will desire grace and beauty, and above both the greenness of a crop.

23 A friend and companion meeting at the time, and above both a wife with a husband.

24 Brothers and help are for a time of affliction, and above both almsgiving will rescue.

25 Gold and silver will establish a foot, and above both counsel is approved.

26 Money and strength will raise a heart, and above both is fear of the Lord; there is no diminution in fear of the Lord, and there is no need to seek help in it;

27 fear of the Lord is like a garden of blessing, and above all glory it covered him.

28 Child, do not live a life of begging; it is better to die than to beg.

29 A man looking to a stranger's table, his existence is not in the reckoning of life; he will defile his soul with strangers' foods; but a knowledgeable and disciplined man will guard himself.

30 In a shameless person's mouth begging will be sweetened, and in his belly fire will burn.

Chapter 41

1 O death, how bitter your remembrance is to a person at peace in his possessions, to a man undistracted and prospering in all things and still strong enough to receive food.

2 O death, good is your judgment for a person needy and diminishing in strength, extremely aged and distracted about everything and disobedient and having lost endurance.

3 Do not be apprehensive of death's judgment; remember those before you and those after;

4 this is the judgment from the Lord for all flesh, and why do you refuse the pleasure of the Most High? Whether ten or a hundred or a thousand years, there is no reproof of life in Hades.

5 Children of sinners become abominable children, and those associating with the dwellings of the ungodly;

6 the inheritance of sinners' children will perish, and with their seed reproach will remain continually.

7 Children will blame an ungodly father, because through him they will be reproached.

8 Woe to you, ungodly men, who abandoned the law of God Most High;

9 and if you are born, you will be born for a curse, and if you die, you will be allotted to a curse.

10 All things which are from earth will go away to earth, so the ungodly from a curse to destruction.

11 The mourning of human beings is in their bodies, but the name of sinners, not good, will be erased.

12 Care about a name, for it will remain for you more than a thousand great treasures of gold;

13 of a good life there is a number of days, and a good name will remain into an age.

14 Keep discipline in peace, children; but hidden wisdom and unseen treasure, what benefit is in both?

15 Better is a person hiding his folly than a person hiding his wisdom.

16 Therefore be ashamed at my utterance; for it is not good to preserve every shame, and not all things are approved by all in faithfulness.

17 Be ashamed before father and mother concerning prostitution, and before leader and ruler concerning falsehood,

18 before judge and ruler concerning transgression, and before congregation and people concerning lawlessness,

19 before partner and friend concerning injustice, and before the place where you sojourn concerning theft,

20 before God's truth and covenant, and for planting an elbow over bread,

21 for contempt of receiving and giving, and before those greeting you concerning silence,

22 for looking at a courtesan, and for turning away a relative's face,

23 for taking away a portion and a gift, and for observing a married woman,

24 for meddling with his maidservant, and do not stand over her bed,

25 before friends concerning words of reproach, and after giving do not reproach,

26 for repeating also a word heard, and for uncovering secret words;

27 and you will be truly modest and find favor before every person.

Chapter 42

1 Do not be ashamed concerning these things, and do not show partiality so as to sin:

2 concerning the law of the Most High and covenant, and concerning judgment to justify the ungodly,

3 concerning a partner's and travelers' word, and concerning giving an inheritance to companions,

4 concerning the exactness of a balance and weights, and concerning acquiring many things and few,

5 concerning profit from merchants' selling, and concerning much discipline of children, and making a wicked household servant's side bleed;

6 over a wicked woman a seal is good, and where hands are many, lock up;

7 whatever you hand over, do so by number and weight, and giving and receiving, everything in writing;

8 concerning discipline of an unthinking person and a fool and an extremely aged person disputing with young people; and you will be truly disciplined and approved before every living being.

9 A daughter is hidden wakefulness for a father, and care for her removes sleep; in her youth, lest she pass her prime, and when married, lest she be hated;

10 in virginity, lest she be profaned and become pregnant in her father's house; being with a husband, lest she transgress, and when married, lest she become barren.

11 Over an unrestrained daughter strengthen your guard, lest she make you a delight for enemies, talk in a city and an outcast of the people, and shame you in a multitude of many.

12 Do not look at any person for beauty, and do not sit together in the midst of women;

13 for from garments a moth comes forth, and from a woman a woman's wickedness.

14 Better is a man's wickedness than a beneficent woman, and a woman shaming to reproach.

15 I will now remember the Lord's works, and what I have seen I will recount; in the Lord's words are his works.

16 The sun, illuminating, looked upon everything, and his work is full of the Lord's glory.

17 He did not enable the Lord's holy ones to recount all his wonders, which the Lord Almighty established for the whole to be supported in his glory.

18 Abyss and heart he traced out, and their cunning devices he considered; for the Most High knew every knowledge and looked into the sign of an age,

19 reporting the things that have passed and the things that will be, and revealing traces of hidden things;

20 No thought escaped him; not even one word was hidden from him.

21 He adorned the great things of his wisdom, as he is before the age and into the age; neither was he added to nor diminished, and he needed no counselor.

22 How desirable are all his works, and one can behold them as a spark;

23 all these live and remain into the age for all uses, and all obey.

24 All things are double, one opposite the other, and he made nothing deficient;

25 one established the other's good things, and who will be filled looking upon his glory?

Chapter 43

1 The pride of height is a firmament of purity, the appearance of heaven in a vision of glory.

2 The sun, at its appearance proclaiming at its departure, is a wondrous vessel, a work of the Most High;

3 at its midday it dries up a country, and before its burning heat who will withstand?

4 One blowing a furnace is amid works of burning heat, the sun threefold, burning mountains; blowing out fiery vapors and flashing rays, it dims eyes.

5 Great is the Lord who made it, and at his words it hastened its course.

6 And the moon in all things is for its time, a showing of times and a sign of an age;

7 from the moon is the sign of a festival, a luminary diminishing to completion.

8 A month is according to its name, increasing wondrously in change, a vessel of encampments on high, shining in the firmament of heaven.

9 The beauty of heaven is the glory of stars, an ornament illuminating in the Lord's heights;

10 at the words of a holy one they will stand according to judgment and certainly not slacken in their watches.

11 See a bow and bless him who made it exceedingly beautiful in its radiance;

12 it encircled heaven in a circuit of glory; hands of the Most High stretched it.

13 By his command he hastened snow, and he speeds the lightnings of his judgment;

14 for this reason treasuries were opened, and clouds flew out like birds;

15 by his greatness he strengthened clouds, and hailstones were shattered;

16 and at his appearance mountains will be shaken; at his will a south wind will blow.

17 The voice of his thunder reproached earth, and a storm of the north and a whirlwind.

18 Like birds flying down he sprinkles snow, and like a locust settling is its descent; an eye will marvel at the beauty of its whiteness, and a heart will be astounded at its falling.

19 And frost like salt he pours upon earth, and when frozen it becomes points of stakes.

20 A cold north wind will blow, and ice will freeze upon water; upon every gathering of water it will settle, and the water will put it on like a breastplate.

21 It will devour mountains and burn a wilderness and quench green grass like fire.

22 Healing of all things speedily is mist; dew meeting it will bring cheer from scorching heat.

23 By his reasoning he stilled an abyss and planted islands in it.

24 Those sailing the sea recount its danger, and at the hearing of our ears we marvel;

25 and there are extraordinary and wondrous works, the variety of every living creature, the creation of sea monsters.

26 Because of him his messenger prospers, and at his word all things are held together.

27 We will say many things and certainly not reach the end, and the conclusion of words is, He is the whole.

28 Glorifying, where will we have strength? For he is great beyond all his works.

29 Fearsome is the Lord and exceedingly great, and wondrous is his might.

30 Glorifying the Lord, exalt him as much as you can, for he will surpass even still; and exalting him, increase in strength; do not grow weary, for you will certainly not reach him.

31 Who has seen him and will recount? And who will magnify him as he is?

32 Many hidden things are greater than these, for we have seen few of his works;

33 for the Lord made all things and gave wisdom to the pious.

Chapter 44

1 Let us now praise glorious men and our fathers by descent;

2 the Lord created much glory, his greatness from an age.

3 Those ruling in their kingdoms and men renowned in power; those counseling in their understanding, those reporting in prophecies;

4 leaders of a people in counsels and in understanding of the people's writing, wise words in their discipline;

5 those seeking out melodies of musicians and recounting verses in writing;

6 rich men supplied with strength, at peace in their dwellings;

7 all these were glorified in generations, and in their days were a boast.

8 There are some of them who left a name for the recounting of praises;

9 and there are those of whom there is no remembrance, and they perished as though they had not existed and became as though they had not come to be, and their children after them.

10 But these are men of mercy, whose righteous deeds were not forgotten;

11 with their seed it will remain, their descendants a good inheritance;

12 in the covenants their seed stood, and their children because of them;

13 until an age their seed will remain, and their glory will not be erased;

14 their bodies were buried in peace, and their name lives for generations;

15 peoples will recount their wisdom, and an assembly proclaims their praise.

16 Enoch pleased the Lord and was transferred, an example of repentance for the generations.

17 Noe was found perfect, righteous; at a time of wrath he became an exchange; through him a remnant came to be for the earth when a flood occurred;

18 covenants of an age were established with him, that all flesh might not be erased by a flood.

19 Abraam is a great father of a multitude of nations, and none was found like him in glory;

20 who kept the law of the Most High and entered a covenant with him; in his flesh he established a covenant, and in testing he was found faithful;

21 for this reason by an oath he established for him that nations be blessed in his seed, to multiply him like the dust of the earth and raise his seed like stars and give them an inheritance from sea to sea and from a river to the extremity of the earth.

22 And in Isaak he established thus because of Abraam his father.

23 The blessing of all human beings and a covenant he caused to rest upon Iakob's head; he recognized him in his blessings and gave to him as an inheritance; and he distinguished his portions, among twelve tribes he divided them.

Chapter 45

1 And from him he brought forth a man of mercy finding favor in the eyes of all flesh, loved by God and human beings, Moyses, whose remembrance is in blessings;

2 he likened him to the glory of holy ones and magnified him in the fears of enemies;

3 at his words he made signs cease; he glorified him before the face of kings; he commanded him concerning his people and showed him of his glory;

4 in faithfulness and gentleness he sanctified him; he chose him from all flesh;

5 he made him hear his voice and brought him into the gloom and gave him commandments face to face, a law of life and knowledge, to teach Iakob a covenant and Israel his judgments.

6 Aaron he exalted as a holy one like him, his brother from the tribe of Levi;

7 he established him as a covenant of an age and gave him the priesthood of a people; he made him blessed in adornment and girded him with a robe of glory;

8 he clothed him with the perfection of boasting and strengthened him with instruments of strength, breeches and a robe reaching to the feet and a shoulder garment;

9 and he encircled him with little pomegranates, with very many golden bells all around, to sound a voice in his steps, to make a sound audible in a temple as a remembrance for sons of his people;

10 with a holy robe, gold and violet and purple, the work of an embroiderer, an oracle of judgment, manifestations of truth, with spun scarlet, an artisan's work,

11 with costly stones of seal engraving in a gold setting, a stone worker's work, for a remembrance in an engraved inscription according to the number of tribes of Israel;

12 a golden crown above a turban, an impression of a seal of holiness, a boast of honor, a work of strength, adorned objects of desire for eyes;

13 before him such beautiful things had not come to be; until an age no one of another race put them on except his sons alone and his descendants continually.

14 His sacrifices will be offered wholly, continually twice each day.

15 Moyses filled his hands and anointed him with holy oil; it became for him a covenant of an age, and for his seed in the days of heaven, to minister to him and also serve as priest and bless his people in the name.

16 He chose him from every living being to bring an offering to the Lord, incense and fragrance for a remembrance, to make atonement for your people.

17 He gave him authority in his commandments, in covenants of judgments, to teach Iakob the testimonies and illuminate Israel in his law.

18 Strangers banded together against him and envied him in the wilderness, the men around Dathan and Abiron and the congregation of Kore, in fury and wrath;

19 the Lord saw and did not take pleasure, and they were brought to an end in fury of wrath; he did portents to them, to consume them in the fire of his flame.

20 And he added glory to Aaron and gave him an inheritance; firstfruits of first produce he allotted him, bread among the first he prepared as a fullness;

21 for they too will eat the Lord's sacrifices, which he gave both to him and to his seed.

22 But in the people's land he will not inherit, and he has no portion among the people; for he himself is your portion and inheritance.

23 And Phinees son of Eleazar is third in glory, in his being zealous in fear of the Lord and his standing at the people's turning in the goodness of his soul's readiness; and he made atonement for Israel.

24 For this reason a covenant of peace was established for him, to preside over holy things and his people, that for him and his seed there might be the greatness of priesthood into the ages.

25 And a covenant for David son of Iessai from the tribe of Iouda, an inheritance of a king, son from son alone; Aaron's inheritance is also for his seed.

26 May he give you wisdom in your heart to judge his people in righteousness, that their good things may not vanish, and their glory for their generations.

Chapter 46

1 Mighty in war is Iesous of Naue, and a successor of Moyses in prophecies, who became, according to his name, great for the salvation of his chosen ones, to take vengeance upon enemies rising up, so as to give Israel an inheritance.

2 How he was glorified in raising his hands and stretching out a sword against cities.

3 Who before him stood thus? For he brought on the Lord's wars.

4 Was not the sun hindered by his hand, and did not one day become as two?

5 He called upon the Most High ruler when enemies pressed him all around, and the great Lord listened to him with hailstones of mighty power;

6 he dashed war down upon a nation and at the descent destroyed those resisting, that nations might know his full armor, because his war is before the Lord.

7 For he too followed after the ruler and in the days of Moyses did mercy, he and Chaleb son of Iephonne, to resist before an assembly, to restrain a people from sin and abate murmuring of wickedness.

8 And they, being two, were preserved out of six hundred thousand foot soldiers, to bring them into an inheritance, into a land flowing with milk and honey.

9 And the Lord gave Chaleb strength, and until old age it remained with him, for him to mount the height of the land, and his seed held an inheritance,

10 so that all the sons of Israel might see that it is good to walk after the Lord.

11 And the judges, each by his own name, whose heart did not prostitute itself and who did not turn away from the Lord, may their remembrance be in blessings;

12 may their bones bloom again from their place, and their name be exchanged anew upon sons of those glorified among them.

13 Loved by his Lord, Samouel, a prophet of the Lord, established a kingdom and anointed rulers over his people;

14 by the Lord's law he judged a congregation, and the Lord inspected Iakob;

15 in his faithfulness he was proven exact as a prophet, and in his utterances he was known as faithful in vision.

16 And he called upon the Lord, the ruler, when his enemies pressed all around, with the offering of a suckling lamb;

17 and the Lord thundered from heaven and with a great sound made his voice audible

18 and wiped out leaders of Tyrians and all rulers of Phylistiim.

19 And before the time of sleep of an age he testified before the Lord and his anointed, Money and even sandals I have not taken from any flesh; and no person accused him.

20 And after falling asleep he prophesied and showed a king his death and raised his voice from earth in prophecy, to erase a people's lawlessness.

Chapter 47

1 And after him Nathan arose to prophesy in the days of David.

2 As fat separated from a salvation offering, so was David from the sons of Israel.

3 With lions he played as with young goats, and with bears as with lambs of sheep.

4 In his youth did he not kill a giant and remove reproach from a people by raising a hand with a sling stone and casting down Goliath's pride?

5 For he called upon the Lord Most High, and he gave strength in his right hand to remove a person powerful in war, to raise the horn of his people.

6 Thus with myriads they glorified him and praised him with the Lord's blessings, when a diadem of glory was brought to him;

7 for he wiped out enemies all around and brought to nothing the hostile Phylistiim; until today he shattered their horn.

8 In every work of his he gave confession to the holy Most High with an utterance of glory; with all his heart he sang hymns and loved him who made him.

9 And he established psalm singers opposite the altar, and from their sound to sweeten melodies;

10 he gave festivals comeliness and adorned seasons to completion, in their praising his holy name and the sanctuary sounding from morning.

11 The Lord took away his sins and raised his horn into an age and gave him a covenant of kings and a throne of glory in Israel.

12 After him a knowledgeable son arose, and because of him he lodged in spaciousness;

13 Salomon reigned in days of peace, for whom God gave rest all around, that he might establish a house in his name and prepare a sanctuary into the age.

14 How you were made wise in your youth and filled like a river with understanding.

15 Your soul covered earth, and you filled it with parables of riddles;

16 to distant islands your name reached, and you were loved in your peace;

17 in songs and proverbs and parables and interpretations countries marveled at you.

18 In the name of the Lord God, called the God of Israel, you gathered gold like tin and multiplied silver like lead.

19 You inclined your loins to women, and you were ruled in your body;

20 you put a blemish on your glory and profaned your seed, to bring wrath upon your children and be pierced at your senselessness,

21 for the sovereignty to become divided and from Ephraim to rule a disobedient kingdom.

22 But the Lord will certainly not abandon his mercy and will certainly not destroy any of his words, nor erase his chosen one's offspring, and the seed of him who loved him he will certainly not remove; and to Iakob he gave a remnant, and to David a root from him.

23 And Salomon rested with his fathers and left after him from his seed the people's senselessness, and Roboam, deficient in understanding, who made a people revolt by his counsel.

24 And Ieroboam son of Nabat, who caused Israel to sin and gave Ephraim a way of sin; and their sins increased exceedingly, to remove them from their land;

25 and they sought out every wickedness until vengeance came upon them.

Chapter 48

1 And Elias arose, a prophet like fire, and his word burned like a torch;

2 who brought famine upon them and by his zeal made them few;

3 by the Lord's word he held back heaven; thus he brought down fire three times.

4 How you were glorified, Elias, in your wonders; and who is like you in boasting?

5 He who raised a dead person from death and from Hades by the word of the Most High;

6 he who brought down kings to destruction and honored ones from their bed;

7 hearing reproof at Sina and judgments of vengeance at Choreb;

8 he who anoints kings for repayment and prophets as successors after him;

9 he who was taken up in a whirlwind of fire, in a chariot of fiery horses;

10 he who was recorded in reproofs for times, to abate wrath before fury, to turn a father's heart toward a son and establish the tribes of Iakob.

11 Blessed are those who saw you and those who have fallen asleep in love; for we too will surely live.

12 Elias, who was sheltered in a whirlwind, and Elisaie was filled with his spirit; and in his days he was not shaken by a ruler, and no one oppressed him.

13 No word surpassed him, and in sleep his body prophesied;

14 and in his life he did portents, and at death his works were wonders.

15 In all these things the people did not repent, and they did not depart from their sins, until they were plundered from their land and dispersed in all the earth.

16 And the people was left very few, and a ruler in the house of David; some of them did what was pleasing, but some multiplied sins.

17 Ezekias fortified his city and brought water into its midst; with iron he dug sheer rock and built fountains for waters.

18 In his days Sennacherim came up and sent Rapsakes, and departed; and he raised his hand against Sion and boasted greatly in his pride.

19 Then their hearts and hands were shaken, and they suffered labor pains like women giving birth;

20 and they called upon the merciful Lord, spreading their hands toward him. And the holy one from heaven quickly listened to them and redeemed them by the hand of Esaias;

21 he struck the camp of the Assyrians, and his angel wiped them out.

22 For Ezekias did what was pleasing to the Lord and strengthened himself in the ways of David his father, which Esaias commanded, the prophet great and faithful in his vision.

23 In his days the sun went backward, and he added life to a king.

24 With a great spirit he saw the last things and comforted those mourning in Sion.

25 Until the age he showed the things that will be, and hidden things before they came to be.

Chapter 49

1 The remembrance of Iosias is like a composition of incense prepared by a perfumer's work; in every mouth it will be sweetened like honey and like music at a drinking party of wine.

2 He was directed in the turning of a people and removed abominations of lawlessness;

3 he directed his heart toward the Lord; in days of the lawless he strengthened piety.

4 Except for David and Ezekias and Iosias, all transgressed a transgression; for they abandoned the law of the Most High; the kings of Iouda ceased;

5 for they gave their horn to others and their glory to a foreign nation.

6 They burned a chosen city of a sanctuary and made its ways desolate

7 by the hand of Ieremias; for they afflicted him, and he was sanctified in the womb as a prophet to uproot and afflict and destroy, likewise to build and plant.

8 Iezekiel, who saw a vision of glory, which he showed him upon a chariot of cheroubin;

9 for he too remembered the enemies in a rainstorm, and to do good to those straightening ways.

10 And may the bones of the twelve prophets bloom again from their place; for they comforted Iakob and redeemed them in faithfulness of hope.

11 How shall we magnify Zorobabel? He too is like a seal upon a right hand,

12 so is Iesous son of Iosedek, who in their days built a house and raised a holy temple for the Lord, prepared for glory of an age.

13 And great is the remembrance of Neemias, who raised for us fallen walls and established gates and bars and rebuilt our house sites.

14 No one was created upon the earth such as Enoch; for he too was taken up from the earth.

15 Nor was a man born like Ioseph, a leader of brothers, a support of a people, and his bones were inspected.

16 Sem and Seth were glorified among human beings, and above every living being in creation was Adam.

Chapter 50

1 Simon son of Onias, the great priest, who in his life repaired a house and in his days strengthened a temple;

2 and by him was founded the height of a double wall, a high support of the temple enclosure;

3 in his days a reservoir of waters was hewn out, a pit with a circumference like that of a sea;

4 he who cared for his people against falling and strengthened a city in a siege.

5 How he was glorified amid the surrounding people, at his departure from the house of the curtain;

6 like a morning star in the midst of clouds, like a full moon in its days,

7 like a sun shining upon the temple of the Most High, and like a bow illuminating in clouds of glory,

8 like a blossom of roses in days of new produce, like lilies at an outlet of water, like a shoot of Lebanon in days of summer,

9 like fire and frankincense upon a firepan, like a vessel of gold wholly hammered, adorned with every costly stone,

10 like an olive budding fruits and like a cypress rising into clouds.

11 When he took up a robe of glory and put on the perfection of boasting, in ascending the holy altar he glorified the enclosure of the sanctuary;

12 and when he received portions from priests' hands, and himself stood by the hearth of the altar, around him was a crown of brothers like a growth of cedars in Lebanon, and they surrounded him like trunks of palms,

13 and all the sons of Aaron in their glory, and the Lord's offering in their hands before all the assembly of Israel,

14 and ministering the completion upon altars, to adorn an offering of the Most High Almighty,

15 he stretched his hand over a libation bowl and poured a libation from the blood of a grape; he poured into the foundations of the altar a fragrant scent for the Most High, king of all.

16 Then the sons of Aaron cried out; with hammered trumpets they sounded, they made a great voice audible for a remembrance before the Most High;

17 then all the people together hastened and fell upon their face upon the earth, to worship their Lord, God Almighty, Most High;

18 and the psalm singers praised with their voices; with very great sound a melody was sweetened;

19 and the people made supplication to the Lord Most High in prayer before the merciful one, until the Lord's adornment was completed and they finished his ministry.

20 Then, coming down, he raised his hands over all the assembly of the sons of Israel, to give the Lord's blessing from his lips and boast in his name;

21 and they repeated their worship to receive the blessing from the Most High.

22 And now bless the God of all, who does great things everywhere, who raises our days from the womb and deals with us according to his mercy.

23 May he give us gladness of heart, and may there be peace in our days in Israel according to the days of the age;

24 may he entrust his mercy to us, and in our days let him redeem us.

25 At two nations my soul was offended, and the third is not a nation;

26 those sitting on a mountain of Samareia, and Phylistiim, and the foolish people dwelling in Sikima.

27 Discipline of understanding and knowledge Iesous son of Sirach Eleazar, the Ierusalemite, inscribed in this book, who rained down wisdom from his heart.

28 Blessed is he who will be occupied with these things, and having placed them upon his heart he will become wise;

29 for if he does them, he will be strong for everything; because the Lord's light is his trace.

Chapter 51

1 I will confess to you, Lord, king, and praise you, God my savior; I confess to your name,

2 because you became my shelter and helper and redeemed my body from destruction and from a snare of a tongue's slander, from lips working falsehood; and before those standing nearby you became a helper and redeemed me,

3 according to the abundance of your mercy and name, from gnashing, ready for food, from the hand of those seeking my soul, from the many afflictions which I had,

4 from the choking of a pyre all around and from the midst of fire which I did not kindle,

5 from the depth of the belly of Hades and from an unclean tongue and a false word.

6 To a king, slander of an unjust tongue. My soul drew near as far as death, and my life was close to Hades below.

7 They surrounded me on every side, and there was no helper; I looked to assistance from human beings, and there was none.

8 And I remembered your mercy, Lord, and your work from an age, that you deliver those awaiting you and save them from the hand of enemies.

9 And I raised my petition from earth and made supplication for rescue from death;

10 I called upon the Lord, father of my lord, not to abandon me in days of affliction, at a time of proud acts, of helplessness; I will praise your name continually and sing hymns in confession.

11 And my supplication was heard; for you saved me from destruction and delivered me from an evil time.

12 For this reason I will confess to you and praise you and bless the Lord's name.

13 While still younger, before I wandered, I sought wisdom openly in my prayer.

14 Before a temple I asked concerning her, and until the last I will seek her out.

15 From blossom, as of a ripening grape, my heart rejoiced in her. My foot stepped in uprightness; from my youth I tracked her.

16 I inclined my ear a little and received, and found much discipline for myself.

17 Progress came to me in her; to him who gives me wisdom I will give glory.

18 For I considered doing her, and I was zealous for the good and will certainly not be ashamed.

19 My soul has struggled in her, and in doing the law I was exact. I spread my hands toward the height and mourned the ignorances of her.

20 I directed my soul toward her and in cleansing found her. I acquired a heart with her from the beginning; for this reason I will certainly not be abandoned.

21 And my belly was troubled to seek her out; for this reason I acquired a good possession.

22 The Lord gave me a tongue as my wage, and with it I will praise him.

23 Draw near to me, undisciplined ones, and lodge in a house of discipline.

24 Why do you say you are lacking in these things, and your souls thirst exceedingly?

25 I opened my mouth and spoke, Acquire for yourselves without silver.

26 Put your neck beneath a yoke, and let your soul receive discipline. She is near to find.

27 See with your eyes that I labored little and found much rest for myself.

28 Partake of discipline with a great number of silver, and acquire much gold in her.

29 May your soul rejoice in his mercy, and may you not be ashamed in his praise.

30 Work your work before the time, and he will give your wage in his time.

Psalms of Solomon

Chapter 1

1 I cried to the Lord when I was afflicted to the utmost, to God when sinners attacked;

2 suddenly a cry of war was heard before me; [I said] He will listen to me, because I was filled with righteousness.

3 I reasoned in my heart that I was filled with righteousness, when I prospered and became abundant in children.

4 Their wealth was spread into all the earth, and their glory to the extremity of the earth.

5 They were raised as far as the stars; they said, They will certainly not fall;

6 and they acted insolently in their good things and did not bear it.

7 Their sins were in hidden places, and I did not know;

8 their lawlessness exceeded the nations before them; they profaned the Lord's holy things with profanation.

Chapter 2

1 t A psalm for Salomon; concerning Ierusalem.

1 When the sinner acted proudly, with a battering ram he cast down fortified walls, and you did not hinder him.

2 Foreign nations ascended upon your altar; they trampled with their sandals in pride,

3 because the sons of Ierusalem defiled the Lord's holy things; they profaned God's gifts with lawlessness.

4 Because of these things he said, Cast them far away from me; I take no pleasure in them.

5 The beauty of her glory was despised before God; it was dishonored to the utmost.

6 The sons and daughters are in evil captivity; their neck is under a seal, under a mark among the nations.

7 According to their sins he did to them, because he abandoned them into the hands of those prevailing.

8 For he turned his face away from mercy toward them, young and old and their children altogether, because they did evil things altogether, not listening.

9 And heaven was deeply grieved, and earth abhorred them, because no person upon it did as much as they did.

10 And earth will know all your righteous judgments, O God.

11 They set the sons of Ierusalem for mockery in place of prostitutes in her; everyone passing by entered before the sun.

12 They mocked their lawlessness just as they themselves were doing; before the sun they exposed their injustices.

13 And the daughters of Ierusalem were profane according to your judgment, because they themselves defiled themselves in the mire of mingling.

14 I suffer pain in my belly and my inward parts over these things.

15 I will justify you, O God, in uprightness of heart, because in your judgments is your righteousness, O God.

16 Because you repaid sinners according to their works and according to their exceedingly wicked sins.

17 You uncovered their sins, that your judgment might appear; you erased their remembrance from earth.

18 God is a righteous judge and will not admire a face.

19 For nations reproached Ierusalem in trampling; her beauty was dragged down from a throne of glory.

20 She girded herself with sackcloth instead of a garment of comeliness, a cord around her head instead of a crown.

21 She removed a turban of glory, which God had put around her; her beauty is in dishonor; she was cast upon the earth.

22 And I saw and made supplication before the Lord's face and said, Let it suffice, Lord, that your hand is heavy upon Ierusalem in the bringing of nations;

23 because they mocked and did not spare, in wrath and fury with resentment; and they will be brought to an end unless you, Lord, rebuke them in your wrath.

24 Because they did not do it in zeal, but in desire of soul to pour out their wrath upon us in plunder.

25 Do not delay, O God, in repaying upon their heads, in declaring the dragon's pride in dishonor.

26 And I did not wait long until God showed me his insolence, pierced upon the mountains of Egypt, despised beyond the least upon earth and sea;

27 his body carried about upon waves in great insult, and there was no one burying him, because he despised him in dishonor.

28 He did not reckon that he is a human being, and he did not reckon the later end.

29 He said, I will be lord of earth and sea; and he did not recognize that God is great, mighty in his great strength.

30 He is king upon the heavens and judges kings and rulers;

31 he who raises me to glory and puts the proud to sleep in destruction of an age, in dishonor, because they did not know him.

32 And now see, great men of the earth, the Lord's judgment, because he is a great king and righteous, judging what is beneath heaven.

33 Bless God, you who fear the Lord with knowledge, because the Lord's mercy is upon those fearing him, with judgment

34 to distinguish between righteous person and sinner, to repay sinners into the age according to their works

35 and have mercy on a righteous person from a sinner's humiliation, and repay a sinner for what he did to a righteous person.

36 Because the Lord is kind to those calling upon him with endurance, to do according to his mercy for his holy ones, to stand continually before him in strength.

37 Blessed is the Lord into the age before his servants.

Chapter 3

1 t A psalm for Salomon; concerning righteous people.

1 Why do you sleep, soul, and not bless the Lord? Sing a new hymn to God, who is to be praised.

2 Sing and keep watch for his watching, because a psalm to God from a good heart is good.

3 The righteous remember the Lord continually, in confession and justification the Lord's judgments.

4 A righteous person will not disregard being disciplined by the Lord; his good will is continually before the Lord.

5 The righteous person stumbled and justified the Lord; he fell and looks to what God will do to him; he watches from where his salvation will come.

6 The truth of the righteous is from God their savior; sin upon sin does not lodge in a righteous person's house;

7 the righteous person continually inspects his house to remove injustice in his transgression.

8 He made atonement for ignorance with fasting and humiliation of his soul, and the Lord cleanses every holy man and his house.

9 A sinner stumbled and curses his life, the day of his birth and his mother's labor pains.

10 He added sins upon sins to his life; he fell, because his fall is evil, and he will not rise.

11 The sinner's destruction is into the age, and he will not be remembered when he inspects the righteous.

12 This is the portion of sinners into the age; but those fearing the Lord will rise to eternal life, and their life is in the Lord's light and will no longer cease.

Chapter 4

1 t A discourse of Salomon; for people-pleasers.

1 Why do you, profane one, sit in a council of holy ones, and your heart has departed far from the Lord, provoking the God of Israel with unlawful deeds?

2 Excessive in words, excessive in signaling beyond everyone, he who is harsh in words to condemn sinners in judgment;

3 and his hand is among the first against him, as in zeal, and he himself is guilty of a variety of sins and of lack of self-control.

4 His eyes are upon every woman without distinction; his tongue is false in a transaction with an oath.

5 At night and in hidden places he sins as though unseen; with his eyes he speaks to every woman in a compact of evil; quick to enter every house cheerfully, as though innocent.

6 May God remove those living hypocritically with holy ones, with corruption of his flesh and poverty in his life;

7 may God uncover the works of people-pleasing human beings, his works in derision and mockery.

8 And may holy ones justify their God's judgment when sinners are removed from before a righteous person, a people-pleaser speaking law with deceit.

9 And their eyes are upon a man's house in stability, like a snake, to dissolve each other's wisdom with words of the unlawful.

10 His words are deceptions for the practice of unjust desire; he did not depart until he prevailed, to scatter as in orphanhood;

11 and he made a house desolate because of unlawful desire; he deceived with words, because there is none seeing and judging;

12 he was filled with this unlawful deed, and his eyes are upon another house, to destroy with words of encouragement.

13 His soul, like Hades, is not filled with all these things.

14 May his portion, Lord, be in dishonor before you, his departure with sighs and his entrance with a curse;

15 his life in pains and poverty and want, Lord, his sleep in griefs and his awakening in perplexities.

16 May sleep be taken away from his temples at night; may he fail in every work of his hands in dishonor.

17 May he enter his house empty-handed, and his house be deficient in everything with which he will fill his soul;

18 his old age in the solitude of childlessness until his taking away.

19 May the flesh of people-pleasers be scattered by beasts, and the bones of the unlawful before the sun in dishonor.

20 May ravens gouge out the eyes of hypocrites, because they made many people's houses desolate in dishonor and scattered them in desire

21 and did not remember God and did not fear God in all these things, and provoked God to wrath and exasperated him.

22 May he remove them from the earth, because they deceived souls of the innocent with false reasoning.

23 Blessed are those fearing the Lord in their innocence; the Lord will rescue them from deceitful people and sinners, and rescue us from every unlawful stumbling block.

24 May God remove those proudly doing every injustice, because the Lord our God is a great and mighty judge in righteousness.

25 May your mercy, Lord, be upon all those loving you.

Chapter 5

1 t A psalm for Salomon.

1 Lord God, I will praise your name in exultation, among those knowing your righteous judgments;

2 because you are kind and merciful, the refuge of the poor; when I cry to you, do not remain silent toward me.

3 For [anyone] will not take spoils from a powerful man; and who will take from all that you made, unless you give?

4 Because a person and his portion are from you by weight; he will not add to increase beyond your judgment, O God.

5 When we are afflicted we will call upon you for help, and you will not turn away our supplication, because you are our God.

6 Do not make your hand heavy upon us, that we may not sin through necessity.

7 And if you do not turn us back, we will not hold back, but we will come to you.

8 For if I hunger, I will cry to you, O God, and you will give to me.

9 The birds and fish you feed when you give rain to deserts for the sprouting of green grass;

10 you prepared fodder in a desert for every living being, and if they hunger, they will raise their face toward you.

11 Kings and rulers and peoples you feed, O God, and who is the hope of poor and needy except you, Lord?

12 And you will listen; because who is kind and equitable except you, to gladden a lowly person's soul when you open your hand in mercy?

13 A person's kindness is with sparing, and tomorrow's too, and if he repeats it without murmuring, even this you might marvel at.

14 But your gift is abundant with kindness and rich, and he whose hope is upon you will not spare in giving.

15 Upon all the earth is your mercy, Lord, in kindness.

16 Blessed is he whom God remembers in a proportion of sufficiency; if a person increases excessively, he sins.

17 What is moderate with righteousness is sufficient, and in this is the Lord's blessing unto fullness with righteousness.

18 May those fearing the Lord rejoice in good things, and your kindness be upon Israel in your kingdom.

19 Blessed is the Lord's glory, because he is our king.

Chapter 6

1 t In hope; for Salomon.

1 Blessed is a man whose heart is ready to call upon the Lord's name; when he remembers the Lord's name he will be saved.

2 His ways are directed by the Lord, and the works of his hands have been guarded by the Lord his God.

3 From a vision of his evil dreams his soul will not be troubled; in crossing rivers and in the tumult of seas he will not be terrified.

4 He rose from his sleep and blessed the Lord's name; for the stability of his heart he sang hymns to his God's name;

5 and he made supplication before the Lord's face concerning all his house, and the Lord heard the prayer of everyone in fear of God.

6 And every request of a soul hoping toward him the Lord fulfills; blessed is the Lord who does mercy to those loving him in truth.

Chapter 7

1 t For Salomon; of turning back.

1 Do not move your tent away from us, O God, that those who hated us without cause may not attack us.

2 Because you repelled them, O God; let their foot not tread the inheritance of your sanctuary.

3 You, by your will, discipline us, and do not give us to nations.

4 For if you send death, you will command it concerning us;

5 because you are merciful and will not be angered so as to bring us to an end.

6 When your name encamps in our midst, we will be shown mercy, and a nation will not prevail against us.

7 Because you are our shield, and we will call upon you, and you will listen to us.

8 Because you will have pity on the race of Israel into the age and will not repel it.

9 And we are beneath your yoke for the age, and the scourge of your discipline.

10 You will direct us at the time of your assistance, to have mercy on the house of Iakob for the day on which you promised them.

Chapter 8

1 t For Salomon; for strife.

1 Affliction and a voice of war my ear heard, a voice of a trumpet sounding slaughter and destruction;

2 a voice of many people like a very great wind, like a storm of much fire carried through a desert.

3 And I said [in] my heart, Where then will God judge him?

4 A voice I heard toward Ierusalem, a city of a sanctuary;

5 my loins were shattered from the hearing, my knees were paralyzed, my heart was afraid, my bones were troubled like flax.

6 I said, They will direct their ways in righteousness.

7 I considered God's judgments from the creation of heaven and earth; I justified God in his judgments from an age.

8 God uncovered their sins before the sun; all the earth knew God's righteous judgments.

9 In underground hidden places were their unlawful deeds, provoking wrath; son with mother and father with daughter were mingled together.

10 Each committed adultery with his neighbor's wife; they made agreements among themselves with an oath concerning these things.

11 They plundered God's holy things as though there were no heir redeeming.

12 They trod the Lord's altar from every uncleanness, and with a discharge of blood they defiled the sacrifices as profane meats.

13 They left no sin which they did not do beyond the nations.

14 For this reason God mixed for them a spirit of wandering; he gave them a cup of unmixed wine to drink unto drunkenness.

15 He brought him from the extremity of the earth, him who strikes mightily; he decreed war upon Ierusalem and her land.

16 The rulers of the land met him with joy; they said to him, Your way is wished for; come, enter with peace.

17 They smoothed rough ways for his entrance, opened gates toward Ierusalem, crowned her walls.

18 He entered like a father into his sons' house with peace; he set his feet with great security.

19 He seized her tower citadels and the wall of Ierusalem, because God brought him with security in their wandering.

20 He destroyed their rulers and everyone wise in counsel; he poured out the blood of those dwelling in Ierusalem like water of uncleanness.

21 He led away their sons and daughters, whom they begot in profanation.

22 They did according to their uncleanness, just as their fathers; they defiled Ierusalem and the things sanctified for God's name.

23 God was justified in his judgments among the nations of the earth, and God's holy ones were like lambs in innocence in their midst.

24 Praiseworthy is the Lord who judges all the earth in his righteousness.

25 Behold now, O God, you showed us your judgment in your righteousness; our eyes saw your judgments, O God.

26 We justified your honored name into ages, because you are the God of righteousness, judging Israel with discipline.

27 Turn your mercy toward us, O God, and have pity on us;

28 gather the dispersion of Israel with mercy and kindness, because your faithfulness is with us.

29 And we hardened our neck, and you are our disciplinarian.

30 Do not overlook us, our God, that nations may not swallow us as though there were no redeemer.

31 And you are our God from the beginning, and our hope is upon you, Lord;

32 and we will not hold back from you, because your judgments upon us are kind.

33 For us and our children is favor into the age; Lord our savior, we will no longer be shaken for the time of the age.

34 Praiseworthy is the Lord in his judgments in the mouth of holy ones, and blessed is Israel by the Lord into the age.

Chapter 9

1 t For Salomon; for reproof.

1 When Israel was led away in exile into a foreign land, when they departed from the Lord who redeemed them, they were cast away from the inheritance which the Lord gave them.

2 In every nation is the dispersion of Israel according to God's utterance, that you may be justified, O God, in your righteousness amid our lawlessness, because you are a righteous judge over all the peoples of the earth.

3 For no one doing unjust things will be hidden from your knowledge, and the righteous deeds of your holy ones are before you, Lord; and where will a person be hidden from your knowledge, O God?

4 Our works are in the choice and authority of our soul, to do righteousness and injustice by the works of our hands; and in your righteousness you inspect sons of human beings.

5 He who does righteousness treasures up life for himself with the Lord, and he who does injustice is himself responsible for his soul in destruction; for the Lord's judgments are in righteousness upon each man and house.

6 To whom will you show kindness, O God, except those calling upon the Lord? You will cleanse a soul amid sins in confession, in declarations, because shame is ours and our faces' concerning everything.

7 And to whom will you forgive sins except those who have sinned? You will bless righteous people and not hold them accountable for what they sinned, and your kindness is upon those sinning in repentance.

8 And now you are God, and we are the people whom you loved; see and have pity, God of Israel, because we are yours, and do not remove your mercy from us, that they may not attack us.

9 Because you chose the seed of Abraam above all the nations and placed your name upon us, Lord, and you will not repel us into the age.

10 In a covenant you made a disposition with our fathers concerning us, and we will hope upon you in the turning of our soul.

11 The Lord's mercy is upon the house of Israel into the age and beyond.

Chapter 10

1 t In hymns; for Salomon.

1 Blessed is a man whom the Lord remembered in reproof, and he was turned around from an evil way by a scourge, to be cleansed from sin so as not to multiply it.

2 He who prepares a back for scourges will be cleansed; for the Lord is kind to those enduring discipline.

3 For he will straighten the ways of righteous people and will not distort them in discipline, and the Lord's mercy is upon those loving him in truth.

4 And the Lord will remember his servants in mercy; for the testimony is in the law of an eternal covenant, the Lord's testimony is upon human ways in inspection.

5 Righteous and holy is our Lord in his judgments into the age, and Israel will praise the Lord's name in gladness.

6 And holy ones will confess in an assembly of the people, and God will have mercy on poor people in Israel's gladness;

7 because God is kind and merciful into the age, and congregations of Israel will glorify the Lord's name.

8 The Lord's salvation is upon the house of Israel unto eternal gladness.

Chapter 11

1 t For Salomon; for expectation.

1 Blow a trumpet in Sion, a trumpet signaling holy things; proclaim in Ierusalem a voice of one announcing good news; because God had mercy on Israel in their inspection.

2 Stand, Ierusalem, on a height and see your children from east and west gathered together by the Lord.

3 From the north they come with the gladness of their God; from distant islands God gathered them.

4 High mountains he lowered to level ground for them; the hills fled from their entrance;

5 the woods shaded them in their passage; every fragrant tree God caused to spring up for them,

6 that Israel might pass in an inspection of their God's glory.

7 Put on, Ierusalem, the garments of your glory; prepare the robe of your sanctuary; because God spoke good things for Israel into the age and beyond.

8 May the Lord do what he spoke concerning Israel and Ierusalem; may the Lord raise Israel in the name of his glory;

9 the Lord's mercy is upon Israel into the age and beyond.

Chapter 12

1 t For Salomon; on the tongue of the unlawful.

1 Lord, rescue my soul from an unlawful and wicked man, from an unlawful and whispering tongue speaking false and deceitful things.

2 In a variety of turns are the words of a wicked man's tongue, like fire among a people kindling its beauty.

3 His dwelling is to burn houses with a false tongue, to cut down trees of gladness that flames against the unlawful, to confound houses in war with whispering lips.

4 May God put the lips of the unlawful far from innocent people in perplexity, and may the bones of whisperers be scattered away from those fearing the Lord; in a fire of flame may a whispering tongue perish away from holy ones.

5 May the Lord guard a quiet soul hating unjust people, and may the Lord direct a man making peace at home.

6 The Lord's salvation is upon Israel his servant into the age; and may sinners perish altogether from before the Lord, and may the Lord's holy ones inherit the Lord's promises.

Chapter 13

1 t A psalm for Salomon; consolation of the righteous.

1 The Lord's right hand sheltered me; the Lord's right hand spared us;

2 the Lord's arm saved us from a passing sword, from famine and the death of sinners.

3 Evil beasts ran against them; with their teeth they tore their flesh, and with their molars they crushed their bones;

4 and from all these things the Lord rescued us.

5 The pious person was troubled because of his transgressions, lest he be taken away together with the sinners;

6 because terrible is the sinner's overthrow, and none of all these things will touch a righteous person.

7 Because the discipline of the righteous in ignorance and the overthrow of sinners are not alike.

8 With restraint a righteous person is disciplined, that the sinner may not rejoice over the righteous person;

9 because he will admonish a righteous person as a beloved son, and his discipline is as that of a firstborn.

10 Because the Lord will spare his holy ones and erase their transgressions by discipline.

11 For the life of the righteous is into the age; but sinners will be taken away to destruction, and their remembrance will no longer be found;

12 but upon the holy ones is the Lord's mercy, and upon those fearing him his mercy.

Chapter 14

1 t A hymn for Salomon.

1 The Lord is faithful to those loving him in truth, to those enduring his discipline,

2 to those walking in the righteousness of his commands, in the law which he commanded us for our life.

3 The Lord's holy ones will live in him into the age; the Lord's garden, the trees of life, are his holy ones.

4 Their planting is rooted into the age; they will not be plucked out all the days of heaven;

5 because Israel is God's portion and inheritance.

6 And not so are the sinners and unlawful, who loved a day in participation in their sin;

7 in the smallness of rottenness is their desire, and they did not remember God.

8 Because human ways are continually known before him, and he knows the heart's chambers before they come to be.

9 For this reason their inheritance is Hades and darkness and destruction, and they will not be found on the day of mercy for the righteous;

10 but the Lord's holy ones will inherit life in gladness.

Chapter 15

1 t A psalm for Salomon with a song.

1 When I was afflicted I called upon the Lord's name; I hoped for help from the God of Iakob and was saved; because you are the hope and refuge of the poor, O God.

2 For who has strength, O God, except to confess to you in truth? And in what is a person powerful except confessing to your name?

3 A new psalm with a song in gladness of heart, fruit of lips with the tuned instrument of a tongue, a firstfruit of lips from a holy and righteous heart,

4 he who does these things will not be shaken into the age by evil; a flame of fire and the wrath of unjust people will not touch him,

5 when it goes forth against sinners from before the Lord to destroy every substance of sinners;

6 because God's sign is upon righteous people for salvation.

7 Famine and sword and death are far from righteous people, for they will flee from holy ones like those pursued in war;

8 but they will pursue sinners and overtake them, and those doing lawlessness will not escape the Lord's judgment;

9 they will be overtaken as by experienced enemies, for the sign of destruction is upon their forehead.

10 And the inheritance of sinners is destruction and darkness, and their lawlessness will pursue them as far as Hades below.

11 Their inheritance will not be found for their children, for sins will make sinners' houses desolate;

12 and sinners will perish into the age on the day of the Lord's judgment, when God inspects the earth with his judgment;

13 but those fearing the Lord will be shown mercy on it and live in the mercy of their God; and sinners will perish for the time of the age.

Chapter 16

1 t A hymn for Salomon; for assistance to holy ones.

1 When my soul grew drowsy away from the Lord, I nearly slipped in the deep sleep of those sleeping far from God,

2 my soul was nearly poured out into death, close to the gates of Hades with a sinner,

3 when my soul was carried away from the Lord God of Israel, had the Lord not helped me by his mercy into the age.

4 He pricked me like a horse's goad for his watching; my savior and helper at every time saved me.

5 I will confess to you, O God, because you helped me unto salvation and did not reckon me with sinners unto destruction.

6 Do not remove your mercy from me, O God, nor remembrance of you from my heart until death.

7 Hold me back, O God, from evil sin and from every wicked woman causing a senseless person to stumble.

8 And let not the beauty of a woman acting unlawfully deceive me, nor that of anything subject to unprofitable sin.

9 Direct the works of my hands in your place, and preserve my steps in remembrance of you.

10 Enclose my tongue and my lips in words of truth; put wrath and irrational fury far from me.

11 Put murmuring and faintheartedness in affliction far from me, if I sin when you discipline for turning back.

12 But with good will and cheerfulness support my soul; when you strengthen my soul, what is given will suffice for me.

13 Because unless you strengthen, who will endure discipline in poverty?

14 When a soul is reproved by the hand of his rottenness, your testing is in his flesh and in the affliction of poverty;

15 when a righteous person endures in these things, he will be shown mercy by the Lord.

Chapter 17

1 t A psalm for Salomon with a song; for the king.

1 Lord, you yourself are our king into the age and beyond; because in you, O God, our soul will boast.

2 And what is the span of a person's life upon the earth? According to his span is his hope upon him too.

3 But we will hope upon God our savior; because our God's might is into the age with mercy, and our God's kingdom is into the age over the nations in judgment.

4 You, Lord, chose David as king over Israel, and you swore to him concerning his seed into the age, that his royal house should not cease before you.

5 And in our sins sinners rose against us; they attacked us and drove us out, those to whom you did not promise; with violence they took away and did not glorify your honored name.

6 In glory they established a royal house in place of their height; they made David's throne desolate in the pride of exchange.

7 And you, O God, will cast them down and remove their seed from the earth when a person foreign to our race rises against them.

8 According to their sins you will repay them, O God, for it to be found for them according to their works.

9 God did not have mercy on them; he searched out their seed and did not leave one of them.

10 Faithful is the Lord in all his judgments which he executes upon the earth.

11 The lawless one made our land desolate of its inhabitants; they made young and old and their children vanish together;

12 in the wrath of his beauty he sent them out as far as the west, and the rulers of the land for mockery, and did not spare.

13 In estrangement the enemy acted proudly, and his heart is estranged from our God.

14 And all that he did in Ierusalem was just as the nations too do in the cities of their strength.

15 And the sons of the covenant dominated them among mixed nations; there was none among them doing mercy and truth in Ierusalem.

16 Those loving congregations of holy ones fled from them; like sparrows they flew out from their resting place.

17 They wandered in deserts to save their souls from evil, and precious in the eyes of sojourning was a soul saved from among them.

18 Into all the earth came their scattering by lawless people, because heaven held back from dripping rain upon the earth.

19 Perennial springs from abysses, from high mountains, were restrained, because there was none among them doing righteousness and judgment.

20 From their ruler and the least of the people they were in every sin, the king in unlawful conduct and the judge in disobedience and the people in sin.

21 See, Lord, and raise for them their king, a son of David, for the time which you chose, O God, for him to reign over Israel your servant;

22 and gird him with strength to shatter unjust rulers, to cleanse Ierusalem from nations trampling in destruction,

23 in wisdom of righteousness to drive sinners out of the inheritance, to wipe out a sinner's pride like a potter's vessels,

24 with an iron rod to shatter all their substance, to destroy unlawful nations with the word of his mouth,

25 at his threat for nations to flee from before him, and to reprove sinners by the word of their heart.

26 And he will gather a holy people whom he will lead in righteousness, and judge the tribes of a people sanctified by the Lord his God;

27 and he will not allow injustice to lodge any longer in their midst, and no person knowing evil will dwell with them; for he will know them, that all of them are sons of God.

28 And he will apportion them in their tribes upon the earth, and a sojourner and one of another race will no longer sojourn with them;

29 he will judge peoples and nations in the wisdom of his righteousness. Musical interlude.

30 And he will have peoples of nations serve him beneath his yoke, and he will glorify the Lord prominently in all the earth and cleanse Ierusalem in sanctification as also from the beginning,

31 for nations to come from the extremity of the earth to see his glory, bringing as gifts her exhausted sons, and to see the Lord's glory with which God glorified her.

32 And he is a righteous king taught by God over them, and there is no injustice in his days among them, because all are holy, and their king is the Lord's anointed.

33 For he will not hope upon horse and rider and bow, nor multiply gold or silver for himself for war, and with many [peoples] he will not gather hopes for a day of war.

34 The Lord himself is his king, the hope of him who is powerful through hope in God, and he will have mercy on all the nations before him in fear.

35 For he will strike earth with the word of his mouth into an age; he will bless the Lord's people with wisdom and gladness;

36 and he is clean from sin to rule a great people, to reprove rulers and remove sinners by the strength of a word.

37 And he will not weaken in his days, relying on his God; because God made him powerful in a holy spirit and wise in counsel of understanding with strength and righteousness.

38 And the Lord's blessing is with him in strength, and he will not weaken.

39 His hope is upon the Lord, and who can prevail against him?

40 Strong in his works and mighty in fear of God, shepherding the Lord's flock in faithfulness and righteousness, and he will not allow weakness among them in their pasture.

41 In equality he will lead them all, and there will be no pride among them, for oppression to occur among them.

42 This is the comeliness of the king of Israel, which God knew, to raise him over the house of Israel to discipline it.

43 His utterances have been refined beyond the foremost precious gold; in congregations he will distinguish the tribes of a sanctified people; his words are like words of holy ones among sanctified peoples.

44 Blessed are those who come to be in those days to see the good things of Israel in a congregation of tribes, which God will do.

45 May God hasten his mercy upon Israel; may he rescue us from the uncleanness of profane enemies.

46 The Lord himself is our king into the age and beyond.

Chapter 18

1 t A psalm for Salomon; further concerning the Lord's anointed.

1 Lord, your mercy is upon the works of your hands into the age, your kindness with a rich gift upon Israel;

2 your eyes look upon them, and none of them will lack; your ears listen to a poor person's supplication in hope.

3 Your judgments are upon all the earth with mercy, and your love upon the seed of Abraam, the sons of Israel.

4 Your discipline is upon us as upon a firstborn, only-begotten son, to turn a listening soul from lack of learning in ignorance.

5 May God cleanse Israel for a day of mercy with blessing, for a day of choosing when he brings up his anointed.

6 Blessed are those who come to be in those days to see the Lord's good things which he will do for the coming generation

7 beneath the rod of discipline of the Lord's anointed, in fear of his God, in wisdom of spirit and righteousness and strength,

8 to direct a man in works of righteousness by fear of God, to establish them all before the Lord,

9 a good generation in fear of God, in days of mercy. Musical interlude.

10 Great is our God and glorious, dwelling in the heights, who arranged luminaries in their course for seasons of hours from days to days, and they did not transgress the way which you commanded them;

11 in fear of God is their way each day, from the day on which God created them and until an age;

12 and they did not wander from the day on which he created them; from ancient generations they did not depart from their ways, unless God commanded them at the bidding of his servants.

Hosea

Chapter 1

1 The Lord's word which came to Osee son of Beeri in the days of Ozias and Ioatham and Achaz and Ezekias, kings of Iouda, and in the days of Ieroboam son of Ioas, king of Israel.

2 The beginning of the Lord's word to Osee; and the Lord said to Osee, Go, take for yourself a wife of prostitution and children of prostitution, because the land will surely prostitute itself away from following the Lord.

3 And he went and took Gomer daughter of Debelaim, and she conceived and bore him a son.

4 And the Lord said to him, Call his name Iezrael, because yet a little while and I will avenge the blood of Iezrael upon the house of Iou and make the kingdom of the house of Israel cease;

5 and it will be on that day, I will shatter Israel's bow in the valley of Iezrael. –

6 And she conceived again and bore a daughter. And he said to him, Call her name Not – shown-mercy, because I will certainly no longer continue to have mercy on the house of Israel, but I will surely oppose them.

7 But I will have mercy on the sons of Iouda and save them by the Lord their God, and I will not save them by bow or sword or war or chariots or horses or horsemen. –

8 And she weaned Not – shown-mercy and conceived again and bore a son.

9 And he said, Call his name Not – my – people, because you are not my people, and I am not yours.

Chapter 2

1 And the number of the sons of Israel was like the sand of the sea, which will not be measured out or counted; and it will be in the place where it was said to them, You are not my people, there they will be called sons of a living God.

2 And the sons of Iouda and the sons of Israel will be gathered together and appoint for themselves one leadership and ascend from the land, because great is the day of Iezrael.

3 Say to your brother, My – people, and to your sister, Shown-mercy.

4 Dispute with your mother, dispute, because she is not my wife, and I am not her husband; and I will remove her prostitution from before my face and her adultery from between her breasts,

5 so that I may strip her naked and restore her as on the day of her birth; and I will make her like a desert and set her like a waterless land and kill her with thirst;

6 and her children I will certainly not show mercy, because they are children of prostitution.

7 Because their mother prostituted herself, she who bore them acted shamefully; for she said, I will follow after my lovers who give me my breads and my water and my garments and my linens and my oil and everything that is due me.

8 For this reason behold, I fence her way with stakes and will build up her ways, and she will certainly not find her path;

9 and she will pursue her lovers and certainly not overtake them; and she will seek them and certainly not find them; and she will say, I will go and return to my former husband, because it was better for me then than now.

10 And she did not know that I have given her the grain and wine and oil, and I multiplied silver for her; but she made silver and gold things for Baal.

11 For this reason I will return and recover my grain at its hour and my wine at its season and take away my garments and my linens so as not to cover her indecency;

12 and now I will uncover her uncleanness before her lovers, and no one will certainly deliver her from my hand;

13 and I will turn away all her gladness, her festivals and her new moons and her sabbaths and all her festal assemblies;

14 and I will make her vine and her fig trees vanish, of which she said, These are my wages which my lovers gave me, and I will make them a testimony, and the beasts of the field and the birds of heaven and the creeping things of earth will devour them;

15 and I will avenge upon her the days of the Baalim, on which she sacrificed to them and put on her earrings and her necklaces and went after her lovers, but forgot me, says the Lord.

16 For this reason behold, I lead her astray and will set her in a desert and speak to her heart

17 and give her her possessions from there and the valley of Achor to open her understanding, and she will be humbled there as in the days of her infancy and as in the days of her ascent from the land of Egypt.

18 And it will be on that day, says the Lord, she will call me, My husband, and no longer call me Baalim;

19 and I will remove the names of the Baalim from her mouth, and their names will certainly no longer be remembered.

20 And I will make for them on that day a covenant with the beasts of the field and with the birds of heaven and with the creeping things of earth; and bow and sword and war I will shatter out of the land and settle you in hope.

21 And I will betroth you to myself into the age, and I will betroth you to myself in righteousness and judgment and mercy and compassion

22 and I will betroth you to myself in faithfulness, and you will know the Lord.

23 And it will be on that day, says the Lord, I will listen to heaven, and heaven will listen to earth,

24 and earth will listen to grain and wine and oil, and they will listen to Iezrael.

25 And I will sow her for myself upon the earth and have mercy on Not – shown-mercy and say to Not – my – people, You are my people, and he will say, You are the Lord my God.

Chapter 3

1 And the Lord said to me, Go again and love a woman loving evil things and an adulteress, just as God loves the sons of Israel, and they look to foreign gods and love cakes with raisins,

2 and I hired for myself for fifteen of silver and a gomor of barley and a nebel of wine

3 and said to her, Many days you will stay with me and certainly not prostitute yourself or belong to another man, and I will be with you.

4 Because many days the sons of Israel will stay without king or ruler or sacrifice or altar or priesthood or manifestations.

5 And after these things the sons of Israel will return and seek the Lord their God and David their king; and they will be astounded at the Lord and at his good things in the last days.

Chapter 4

1 Hear the Lord's word, sons of Israel, because the Lord has a judgment against those dwelling in the land, because there is no truth or mercy or knowledge of God upon the earth;

2 curse and falsehood and murder and theft and adultery have been poured upon the earth, and they mingle blood with blood.

3 For this reason the earth will mourn and be diminished with all those dwelling in it, with the beasts of the field and with the creeping things of earth and with the birds of heaven, and the fish of the sea will cease,

4 so that no one may either litigate or reprove anyone; but my people is like a priest contradicted.

5 And you will weaken by day, and a prophet too will weaken with you; to night I likened your mother.

6 My people was likened to one not having knowledge; because you rejected knowledge, I too will reject you from serving me as priest; and you forgot your God's law, and I too will forget your children.

7 According to their multitude, so they sinned against me; their glory I will make dishonor.

8 They will eat the sins of my people, and in their injustices they will take their souls.

9 And it will be, as the people, so also the priest, and I will avenge his ways upon him and repay him his counsels.

10 And they will eat and certainly not be filled; they prostituted themselves and certainly will not prosper, because they abandoned the Lord, to keep him.

11 Prostitution and wine and intoxicating drink the heart of my people received.

12 With signs they inquired, and with his rods they reported to him; by a spirit of prostitution they were led astray and prostituted themselves away from their God.

13 Upon the summits of mountains they sacrificed, and upon hills they offered sacrifices, beneath oak and poplar and a shading tree, because shelter is good. For this reason your daughters will prostitute themselves, and your daughters-in-law will commit adultery;

14 and I will certainly not inspect your daughters when they prostitute themselves, and your daughters-in-law when they commit adultery, because they themselves too mingled with prostitutes and sacrificed with the initiated, and the people that understands entangled itself with a prostitute.

15 But you, Israel, do not be ignorant, and Iouda, do not enter Galgala and do not ascend to the house of On and do not swear by the living Lord.

16 Because like a frenzied heifer Israel became frenzied; now the Lord will pasture them like a lamb in a broad place.

17 Ephraim, a partner of idols, set stumbling blocks for himself.

18 He chose Chananites; they surely prostituted themselves; they loved dishonor out of their arrogance.

19 You are a whirlwind in her wings, and they will be ashamed because of their altars.

Chapter 5

1 Hear these things, priests, and attend, house of Israel, and house of the king, give ear, because judgment is against you, because you became a snare at the lookout and like a net stretched upon Itabyrion,

2 which those hunting prey fixed. But I am your disciplinarian;

3 I knew Ephraim, and Israel is not absent from me, because now Ephraim prostituted himself, Israel was defiled;

4 they did not give their counsels to returning to their God, because a spirit of prostitution is in them, but they did not know the Lord.

5 And Israel's insolence will be humbled before his face, and Israel and Ephraim will weaken in their injustices, and Ioudas too will weaken with them.

6 With sheep and calves they will go to seek out the Lord and certainly not find him, because he turned away from them,

7 because they abandoned the Lord, because foreign children were born to them; now mildew will devour them and their allotted portions.

8 Blow a trumpet upon the hills, sound upon the heights, proclaim in the house of On; Beniamin was astounded,

9 Ephraim became a desolation in days of reproof; among the tribes of Israel I showed faithful things.

10 The rulers of Iouda became like those moving boundaries; upon them I will pour my onslaught like water.

11 Ephraim oppressed his adversary, trampled judgment, because he began to walk after vain things.

12 And I am like trouble to Ephraim and like a goad to the house of Iouda.

13 And Ephraim saw his disease, and Ioudas his pain, and Ephraim went to Assyrians and sent ambassadors to King Iarim; and he was unable to heal you, and pain will certainly not cease from you.

14 Because I am like a panther to Ephraim and like a lion to the house of Iouda; and I seize and will go and take, and there will be no deliverer.

15 I will go and return to my place until they vanish; and they will seek my face; in their affliction they will rise early toward me, saying,

Chapter 6

1 Let us go and return to the Lord our God, because he has seized and will heal us; he will strike and dress our wounds;

2 he will make us healthy after two days; on the third day we will rise and live before him;

3 and we will know, we will pursue knowing the Lord; like prepared dawn we will find him, and he will come to us like early and late rain upon the earth. –

4 What shall I do to you, Ephraim? What shall I do to you, Iouda? But your mercy is like a morning cloud and like departing early dew.

5 For this reason I reaped your prophets, killed them by the utterances of my mouth, and my judgment will go forth like light.

6 Because I desire mercy and not sacrifice, and knowledge of God rather than whole burnt offerings.

7 But they are like a person transgressing a covenant; there he despised me.

8 Galaad is a city working vain things, troubling water,

9 and your strength is that of a pirate; priests hid the Lord's way, murdered Sikima, because they did lawlessness.

10 In the house of Israel I saw horrifying things, there Ephraim's prostitution; Israel and Iouda were defiled.

11 Begin to gather a vintage for yourself when I turn back the captivity of my people,

Chapter 7

1 when I heal Israel. And the injustice of Ephraim and the evil of Samareia will be uncovered, because they worked false things; and a thief will enter toward him, a robber stripping on his way,

2 so that they may sing together as those singing together with their heart. All their evils I remembered; now their counsels surrounded them; they came before my face.

3 With their evils they gladdened kings, and with their falsehoods rulers;

4 all committing adultery, like an oven burning for baking, with a burning heat from the flame, from the kneading of fat until it is leavened.

5 The days of your kings, the rulers began to become furious from wine; he stretched his hand with pestilent people;

6 because their hearts were kindled like an oven when they dashed them down; all night Ephraim was filled with sleep; morning came, he was kindled like the glow of fire.

7 All were heated like an oven and devoured their judges; all their kings fell; there was none among them calling upon me.

8 Ephraim mingled together among his peoples; Ephraim became a cake not turned.

9 Strangers devoured his strength, but he did not recognize it; and gray hairs blossomed upon him, and he did not know.

10 And Israel's insolence will be humbled before his face, and they did not return to the Lord their God or seek him out in all these things.

11 And Ephraim was like a mindless dove not having a heart; he called upon Egypt, and they went to Assyrians.

12 As they go, I will throw my net upon them; like the birds of heaven I will bring them down; I will discipline them at the hearing of their affliction.

13 Woe to them, because they leaped away from me; they are wretched, because they acted impiously against me; but I redeemed them, and they spoke falsehoods against me.

14 And their hearts did not cry to me, but they wailed upon their beds; over grain and wine they cut themselves. They were disciplined by me,

15 and I strengthened their arms, and against me they devised evil things.

16 They turned away to nothing, became like a drawn bow; their rulers will fall by a sword because of their tongue's lack of discipline; this is their contempt in the land of Egypt.

Chapter 8

1 Into their bosom like earth, like an eagle upon the Lord's house, because they transgressed my covenant and acted impiously against my law.

2 They will cry to me, O God, we have known you.

3 Because Israel turned away good things, they pursued an enemy.

4 They reigned for themselves and not through me; they ruled and did not make it known to me; their silver and gold they made into idols for themselves, so that they might be destroyed.

5 Wipe away your calf, Samareia; my fury was provoked against them; how long will they be unable to be cleansed

6 in Israel? And an artisan made it, and it is not God; because your calf was leading astray, Samareia.

7 Because they sowed wind-blighted things, and their overthrow will receive them; a sheaf not having strength to make flour; but even if it makes it, strangers will devour it.

8 Israel was swallowed; now he became among the nations like a useless vessel.

9 Because they ascended to Assyrians; Ephraim blossomed by himself; they loved gifts;

10 for this reason they will be handed over among the nations. Now I will receive them, and they will cease a little from anointing a king and rulers.

11 Because Ephraim multiplied altars, beloved altars became sins for him.

12 I will record for him a multitude and his ordinances; the beloved altars were reckoned as foreign things.

13 Because if they sacrifice a sacrifice and eat meat, the Lord will not accept them; now he will remember their injustices and avenge their sins; they returned to Egypt and will eat unclean things among Assyrians.

14 And Israel forgot him who made him, and they built sacred precincts, and Ioudas multiplied walled cities; and I will send fire into his cities, and it will devour their foundations.

Chapter 9

1 Do not rejoice, Israel, or be glad like the peoples; because you prostituted yourself away from your God, you loved gifts upon every threshing floor of grain.

2 Threshing floor and winepress did not know them, and wine deceived them.

3 They did not dwell in the Lord's land; Ephraim dwelt in Egypt, and among Assyrians they will eat unclean things.

4 They did not pour wine to the Lord or please him; their sacrifices are like bread of mourning for them; all eating them will be defiled, because their breads for their souls will not enter the Lord's house.

5 What will you do on a day of festal assembly and on a day of the Lord's festival?

6 For this reason behold, they will go out of Egypt's misery, and Memphis will receive them, and Machmas will bury them; destruction will inherit their silver, thorns in their tents.

7 The days of vengeance have come, the days of your repayment have come, and Israel will be afflicted like the deranged prophet, the spirit-bearing person; by the multitude of your injustices your madness increased.

8 Ephraim's watcher is with God; a prophet, a crooked snare upon all his ways; they fixed madness in the Lord's house.

9 They were corrupted as in the days of the hill; he will remember his injustice, avenge his sins.

10 Like a grape in a desert I found Israel, and like an early lookout in a fig tree I saw their fathers; they entered toward Beelphegor and were estranged unto shame, and the beloved became like the abhorred.

11 Ephraim flew out like a bird, their glories from births and labor pains and conceptions;

12 because even if they rear their children, they will be bereaved of human beings; because woe too is theirs, my flesh from them.

13 Ephraim, as I saw, they presented their children for prey, and Ephraim is to bring out his children for piercing.

14 Give them, Lord; what will you give them? Give them a childless womb and dry breasts.

15 All their evils are at Galgal, because there I hated them; because of the evils of their practices I will cast them out of my house; I will certainly no longer continue to love them; all their rulers are disobedient.

16 Ephraim suffered pain, was dried up in his roots; he will certainly no longer bear fruit; because even if they beget, I will kill the desired things of their belly.

17 God will reject them, because they did not listen to him, and they will be wanderers among the nations.

Chapter 10

1 Israel is a vine with good branches, its fruit flourishing; according to the abundance of his fruits he multiplied altars; according to the good things of his land he built pillars.

2 They divided their hearts; now they will vanish; he will demolish their altars; their pillars will suffer misery.

3 Because now they will say, We have no king, because we did not fear the Lord, and what will the king do for us?

4 Speaking utterances, false pretexts, he will make a covenant; judgment will spring up like couch grass upon a fallow field.

5 Those dwelling in Samareia will sojourn with the calf of the house of On, because its people mourned over it; and as they embittered it, they will rejoice over its glory, because it was removed from it.

6 And having bound it they carried it away to Assyrians as gifts for King Iarim; Ephraim will receive in a gift, and Israel will be ashamed in his counsel.

7 Samareia cast away her king like brushwood upon the face of water.

8 And the altars of On, the sins of Israel, will be removed; thorns and thistles will grow upon their altars; and they will say to mountains, Cover us, and to hills, Fall upon us.

9 Since the hills, Israel sinned, there they stood; will war against the children of injustice certainly not overtake them on the hill?

10 He came to discipline them, and peoples will gather against them when they are disciplined for their two injustices.

11 Ephraim is a heifer taught to love strife, but I will come upon the most beautiful part of her neck; I will mount Ephraim and pass over Iouda in silence; Iakob will strengthen him.

12 Sow for yourselves unto righteousness, gather a vintage unto fruit of life, illuminate for yourselves a light of knowledge, seek out the Lord until produce of righteousness comes to you.

13 Why did you pass over impiety in silence and gather its injustices as a vintage, eat false fruit? Because you hoped in your chariots, in the multitude of your force.

14 And destruction will arise among your people, and all your walled places will be gone; as ruler Salaman from the house of Ierobaal, in days of war they dashed a mother upon her children.

15 Thus I will do to you, house of Israel, because of your evils; at dawn they were cast away, the king of Israel was cast away.

Chapter 11

1 Because Israel was an infant, and I loved him and called back his children from Egypt.

2 As I called them back, so they departed from before me; they sacrificed to the Baalim and burned incense to carved things.

3 And I bound Ephraim's feet together, took him upon my arm, and they did not know that I have healed them.

4 In human corruption I stretched them with bonds of my love, and I will be to them like a person slapping upon his cheeks; and I will look toward him, I will be able for him.

5 Ephraim dwelt in Egypt, and Assour himself is his king, because he did not wish to return.

6 And a sword weakened in his cities and ceased in his hands, and they will eat from their counsels.

7 And his people is hanging from his dwelling, and God will be furious over his precious things and certainly not exalt him.

8 How shall I dispose of you, Ephraim? Shall I shield you, Israel? How shall I dispose of you? Shall I make you like Adama and like Seboim? My heart turned within itself; my regret was troubled together.

9 I will certainly not do according to the wrath of my fury; I will certainly not abandon Ephraim to be erased; because I am God and not a human being; holy among you, and I will not enter a city.

10 I will walk after the Lord; like a lion he will roar, because he will roar, and children of waters will be astounded.

11 And they will be astounded like a bird from Egypt and like a dove from the land of Assyrians; and I will restore them to their houses, says the Lord.

Chapter 12

1 Ephraim surrounded me with falsehood, and the house of Israel and Iouda with impieties. Now God knew them, and it will be called God's holy people.

2 But Ephraim is an evil spirit; he pursued scorching heat all day; he multiplied empty and vain things and made a covenant with Assyrians, and oil was traded into Egypt.

3 And the Lord has a judgment against Iouda, to avenge Iakob according to his ways, and according to his practices he will repay him.

4 In the womb he took his brother by the heel, and in his labors he prevailed against God

5 and prevailed with an angel and had strength; they wept and made supplication to me; in the house of On they found me, and there it was spoken to him.

6 But the Lord God Almighty will be his remembrance.

7 And you will return by your God; keep mercy and judgment and draw near to your God continually.

8 Chanaan, in his hand is a balance of injustice; he loved to oppress.

9 And Ephraim said, Nevertheless I have become rich, I have found refreshment for myself. All his labors will not be found for him because of injustices which he sinned.

10 But I, the Lord your God, brought you up from the land of Egypt; still I will settle you in tents as on a day of festival.

11 And I will speak to prophets, and I multiplied visions and was likened by the hands of prophets.

12 Unless it is Galaad; then the rulers sacrificing in Galgal were false, and their altars are like turtles upon a fallow field.

13 And Iakob withdrew to the plain of Syria, and Israel served for a wife and guarded for a wife.

14 And by a prophet the Lord brought Israel up from Egypt, and by a prophet he was preserved.

15 Ephraim enraged and provoked to wrath, and his blood will be poured upon him, and the Lord will repay him his reproach.

Chapter 13

1 According to Ephraim's word he received ordinances in Israel, and he assigned them to Baal and died.

2 And he continued to sin still, and they made for themselves a molten thing from their silver according to an image of idols, works of artisans completed for them; they say, Sacrifice human beings, for calves have ceased.

3 For this reason they will be like a morning cloud and like departing early dew, like chaff blown from a threshing floor and like vapor from locusts.

4 But I am the Lord your God, establishing heaven and creating earth, whose hands created all the host of heaven, and I did not show them to you for you to walk after them; and I brought you up from the land of Egypt, and you will know no God except me, and there is no savior apart from me.

5 I shepherded you in the desert, in an uninhabited land,

6 according to their pastures. And they were filled unto fullness, and their hearts were exalted; because of this they forgot me.

7 And I will be to them like a panther and like a leopard along the way of Assyrians;

8 I will meet them like a bear in want and tear open the enclosure of their heart, and there cubs of the forest will devour them; beasts of the field will tear them apart.

9 In your corruption, Israel, who will help?

10 Where is this king of yours? And let him preserve you in all your cities; let him judge you, he of whom you said, Give me a king and a ruler.

11 And I gave you a king in my wrath, and in my fury I held

12 a gathering of injustice. Ephraim, his sin is hidden away.

13 Labor pains like those of a woman giving birth will come to him; this son of yours is not prudent, because he will certainly not withstand the crushing of children.

14 From the hand of Hades I will rescue them, and from death I will redeem them; where is your penalty, death? Where is your goad, Hades? Consolation has been hidden from my eyes.

15 Because this one will distinguish among brothers. The Lord will bring a scorching wind from the desert upon him and dry up his veins, make his springs desolate; he will dry up his land and all his desirable vessels.

Chapter 14

1 Samareia will vanish, because she resisted her God; they will fall by a sword, and their sucklings will be dashed upon the ground, and their pregnant women will be torn open.

2 Return, Israel, to the Lord your God, because you weakened in your injustices.

3 Take words with yourselves and return to the Lord your God; say to him, so that you may not receive injustice and may receive good things, and we will repay the fruit of our lips.

4 Assour will certainly not save us; we will not mount a horse; we will certainly no longer say, Our gods, to the works of our hands; he who is in you will have mercy on an orphan.

5 I will heal their dwellings, love them openly, because my wrath turned away from them.

6 I will be like dew to Israel; he will blossom like a lily and put forth his roots like Lebanon;

7 his branches will spread, and he will be like a fruitful olive, and his scent like Lebanon;

8 they will return and sit beneath his shelter, live and be drenched with grain; and his remembrance will blossom like a vine, like wine of Lebanon.

9 For Ephraim, what has he still to do with idols? I humbled him, and I will strengthen him; I am like a leafy juniper; from me your fruit has been found.

10 Who is wise and will understand these things? Or understanding and will know them? Because the Lord's ways are straight, and righteous people will walk in them, but the ungodly will weaken in them.

Amos

Chapter 1

1 Words of Amos, which came to be among the nakkarim from Thekoue, which he saw concerning Ierusalem in the days of Ozias king of Iouda and in the days of Ieroboam son of Ioas, king of Israel, two years before the earthquake.

2 And he said: The Lord uttered from Sion and gave his voice from Ierusalem, and the pastures of the shepherds mourned, and the summit of Karmel dried up.

3 And the Lord said: For the three impieties of Damascus and for the four I will not turn him away, because they were sawing with iron saws the pregnant women among those in Galaad;

4 and I will send out fire into the house of Azael, and it will devour the foundations of the son of Ader;

5 and I will shatter the bars of Damascus and destroy inhabitants from the plain of On, and cut down a tribe from the men of Charran, and the people of Syria called by name will be taken captive, says the Lord.

6 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of Gaza and for the four I will not turn them away, because they took captive the captivity of Salomon to shut it up into Idoumaia;

7 and I will send out fire upon the walls of Gaza, and it will devour her foundations;

8 and I will destroy inhabitants from Azotos, and a tribe will be removed from Askalon, and I will bring my hand upon Akkaron, and the remaining ones of the foreigners will perish, says the Lord.

9 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of Tyre and for the four I will not turn her away, because they shut up the captivity of Salomon into Idoumaia and did not remember a covenant of brothers;

10 and I will send out fire upon the walls of Tyre, and it will devour her foundations.

11 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of Idoumaia and for the four I will not turn them away, because they pursued his brother with a sword, and he ravaged a womb upon the earth, and seized his shuddering for a testimony, and kept his impulse for strife;

12 and I will send out fire into Thaiman, and it will devour the foundations of her walls.

13 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of the sons of Ammon and for the four I will not turn him away, because they ripped open the pregnant women of the Galaadites, so that they might widen their boundaries;

14 and I will kindle fire upon the walls of Rabba, and it will devour her foundations with shouting on a day of war, and she will be shaken on the day of her consummation;

15 and her kings will go into captivity, their priests and their rulers together, says the Lord.

Chapter 2

1 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of Moab and for the four I will not turn him away, because they burned the bones of the king of Idoumaia into lime;

2 and I will send out fire upon Moab, and it will devour the foundations of her cities, and Moab will die in weakness, with shouting and with the sound of a trumpet;

3 and I will destroy a judge from her, and I will kill all her rulers with him, says the Lord.

4 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of the sons of Iouda and for the four I will not turn him away, because they rejected the law of the Lord and did not keep his ordinances, and their vain things which they made led them astray, after which their fathers followed;

5 and I will send out fire upon Iouda, and it will devour the foundations of Ierusalem.

6 Thus says the Lord: For the three impieties of Israel and for the four I will not turn him away, because they sold a righteous one for silver and a needy one for the sake of sandals,

7 which tread upon the dust of the earth, and they struck the heads of the poor with their fists and turned aside the way of the lowly, and a son and his father were going in to the same girl, so that they might profane the name of their God,

8 and, binding their garments with cords, they made curtains adjoining the altar, and they drank wine from extortions in the house of their God.

9 But I removed the Amorrite from before them, whose height was like the height of a cedar, and he was strong as an oak, and I removed his fruit from above and his roots from below;

10 and I brought you up from the land of Egypt and led you about in the wilderness forty years, to inherit the land of the Amorrites;

11 and I took from your sons for prophets and from your young men for sanctification. Are these things not so, sons of Israel? says the Lord.

12 And you were giving the sanctified ones wine to drink, and commanding the prophets, saying: You shall certainly not prophesy.

13 Therefore, behold, I roll beneath you, as the wagon full of straw rolls;

14 and escape will perish from a runner, and the strong one will certainly not retain his strength, and the warrior will certainly not save his soul,

15 and the archer will certainly not stand firm, and the one swift on his feet will certainly not be saved, nor will the horseman save his soul,

16 and he will find his heart in mighty deeds; the naked one will pursue on that day, says the Lord.

Chapter 3

1 Hear this word which the Lord spoke against you, house of Israel, and against every tribe which I brought up from the land of Egypt, saying:

2 Only you have I known out of all the tribes of the earth; therefore I will punish all your sins upon you.

3 Will two go together at all unless they make themselves known?

4 Will a lion roar from his thicket without having prey? Will a young lion give his voice from his enclosure at all unless he seizes something?

5 Will a bird fall upon the earth without a birdcatcher? Will a snare be sprung upon the earth without catching something?

6 Will a trumpet sound in a city and the people not be terrified? Will there be evil in a city which the Lord has not done?

7 For the Lord God will certainly not do a thing unless he reveals his discipline to his servants the prophets.

8 A lion will roar, and who will not fear? The Lord God has spoken, and who will not prophesy?

9 Report to regions among the Assyrians and to the regions of Egypt, and say: Gather upon the mountain of Samareia, and see many astonishing things in her midst and the oppression in her;

10 and he did not know what will be against her, says the Lord, those treasuring injustice and misery in their regions.

11 Therefore thus says the Lord God: Tyre, your land will be laid waste round about, and he will bring down your strength from you, and your regions will be plundered.

12 Thus says the Lord: As when the shepherd pulls two legs or a lobe of an ear from the mouth of the lion, so will the sons of Israel be pulled out, those dwelling in Samareia opposite a tribe, and priests in Damascus.

13 Hear and bear witness to the house of Iakob, says the Lord God the Almighty,

14 for on the day when I punish the impieties of Israel upon him, I will also punish the altars of Baithel, and the horns of the altar will be torn down and fall upon the earth;

15 I will demolish and strike the house surrounded by columns upon the summer house, and ivory houses will perish, and many other houses will be added, says the Lord.

Chapter 4

1 Hear this word, heifers of Basanitis who are on the mountain of Samareia, who oppress the poor and trample the needy, who say to their lords: Give to us so that we may drink;

2 The Lord swears by his holy things: For behold, days are coming upon you, and they will take you with weapons, and fiery plagues will cast those with you into cauldrons heated from beneath,

3 and you will be carried out naked, opposite one another, and cast away onto the mountain Remman, says the Lord God.

4 You entered Baithel and acted lawlessly, and in Galgala you multiplied impiety, and brought your sacrifices in the morning, your tithes on the third day;

5 and they read a law outside and called for pledges; report that the sons of Israel loved these things, says the Lord God.

6 And I will give you aching teeth in all your cities and lack of bread in all your places; and you did not return to me, says the Lord.

7 And I withheld the rain from you three months before the harvest; and I will rain upon one city, but upon one city I will not rain; one portion will be rained upon, and a portion upon which I will not rain will dry up;

8 and two and three cities will gather into one city to drink water and will certainly not be filled; and you did not return to me, says the Lord.

9 I struck you with scorching and with jaundice; you multiplied your gardens; the caterpillar devoured your vineyards and your fig orchards and your olive groves; and not even thus did you return to me, says the Lord.

10 I sent out death among you on the way of Egypt, and killed your young men with a sword, along with the captivity of your horses, and brought up your camps in fire in my wrath; and not even thus did you return to me, says the Lord.

11 I overturned you, as God overturned Sodoma and Gomorra, and you became like a firebrand pulled out of fire; and not even thus did you return to me, says the Lord.

12 Therefore I will do thus to you, Israel; nevertheless, because I will do thus to you, prepare to call upon your God, Israel.

13 For behold, I am the one establishing thunder and creating spirit and announcing his anointed one to men, making dawn and mist and stepping upon the heights of the earth; the Lord God the Almighty is his name.

Chapter 5

1 Hear this word of the Lord, which I take up as a lament against you, house of Israel:

2 The virgin of Israel has fallen; she will certainly no longer rise again; she stumbled upon her land; there is no one who will raise her.

3 For thus says the Lord Lord: The city from which a thousand were going out will have a hundred left, and that from which a hundred were going out will have ten left for the house of Israel.

4 For thus says the Lord to the house of Israel: Seek me out and you will live;

5 and do not seek out Baithel, and do not enter Galgala, and do not cross over to the well of the oath, because Galgala, being taken captive, will be taken captive, and Baithel will be as though not existing;

6 seek out the Lord and live, so that the house of Ioseph may not blaze up like fire, and it will devour him, and there will be no one to quench it for the house of Israel.

7 The Lord, who makes judgment on high, and he placed righteousness upon the earth,

8 making all things and refashioning them and turning the shadow of death into morning and darkening day into night, who summons the water of the sea and pours it out upon the face of the earth; the Lord God the Almighty is his name;

9 who apportions crushing upon strength and brings misery upon a stronghold.

10 They hated one reproving in the gates and abhorred a holy word.

11 Therefore, because you were striking the poor with your fists and received choice gifts from them, you built houses of dressed stone and will certainly not dwell in them; you planted desirable vineyards and will certainly not drink the wine from them.

12 For I knew your many impieties, and your sins are mighty, trampling a righteous one, taking payments and turning aside the needy in the gates.

13 Therefore the one who understands will be silent at that time, because it is an evil time.

14 Seek out the good and not the evil, so that you may live; and thus the Lord God the Almighty will be with you, as you said:

15 We have hated evil things and loved good things; and restore judgment in the gates, so that the Lord God the Almighty may have mercy on the remaining ones of Ioseph.

16 Therefore thus says the Lord God the Almighty: In all squares, beating of the breast, and in all streets it will be said: Woe, woe; a farmer will be called to mourning and beating of the breast, and to those who know lamentation,

17 and in all streets, beating of the breast, because I will pass through your midst, said the Lord.

18 Woe to those desiring the day of the Lord; why is this day of the Lord for you? And it is darkness and not light,

19 as when a man flees from before the lion and the bear encounters him, and he leaps into his house and rests his hands against the wall, and the serpent bites him.

20 Is not the day of the Lord darkness and not light? And gloom, having no brightness in it.

21 I have hated, I have rejected your feasts, and I will certainly not smell at your assemblies;

22 for even if you bring me whole burnt offerings and your sacrifices, I will not accept them, and I will not look upon your splendid offerings of salvation.

23 Remove from me the sound of your songs, and I will not hear the music of your instruments;

24 and judgment will roll like water, and righteousness like an impassable torrent.

25 Did you offer me slaughtered offerings and sacrifices in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel?

26 And you took up the tent of Moloch and the star of your god Raiphan, their figures which you made for yourselves.

27 And I will resettle you beyond Damascus, says the Lord; God the Almighty is his name.

Chapter 6

1 Woe to those despising Sion and those trusting in the mountain of Samareia; they harvested the firstfruits of nations, and they entered. House of Israel,

2 cross over, all of you, and see, and pass from there into Emath Rabba, and go down from there into Geth of the foreigners, the strongest of all these kingdoms, whether their boundaries are greater than your boundaries.

3 Those coming to an evil day, those approaching and laying hold of false sabbaths,

4 those sleeping upon ivory beds and living luxuriously upon their couches, and eating kids from flocks and suckling calves from the midst of herds,

5 those clapping to the sound of the instruments reckoned them as standing and not as fleeing;

6 those drinking the filtered wine and anointing themselves with the foremost perfumes, and they suffered nothing over the crushing of Ioseph.

7 Therefore now they will be captives from the foremost of the potentates, and the neighing of horses will be removed from Ephraim.

8 For the Lord swore by himself: For I abhor all the arrogance of Iakob and have hated his regions, and I will remove a city together with all who dwell in it;

9 and it will be, if ten men are left in one house, they too will die, and the remaining ones will be left,

10 and their relatives will take them and force themselves to carry their bones out of the house; and he will say to those in charge of the house: Is there still anyone with you? And he will say: No longer; and he will say: Be silent, so as not to name the name of the Lord.

11 For behold, the Lord commands, and he will strike the great house with crushings and the small house with fissures.

12 Will horses pursue on rocks? Will they keep silent among mares? For you turned judgment into wrath and the fruit of righteousness into bitterness,

13 those rejoicing over no matter, those saying: Did we not acquire horns by our strength?

14 For behold, I raise up a nation against you, house of Israel, and they will press you out so that you do not enter Emath, and as far as the torrent of the west.

Chapter 7

1 Thus the Lord showed me, and behold, a brood of locusts coming in the morning, and behold, one locust, Gog the king.

2 And it will be, if it finishes devouring the grass of the earth, and I said: Lord Lord, be gracious; who will raise Iakob? For he is very small;

3 change your mind, Lord, over this. And this will not be, says the Lord.

4 Thus the Lord showed me, and behold, the Lord called for punishment by fire, and it devoured the great abyss and devoured the portion.

5 And I said: Lord Lord, cease now; who will raise Iakob? For he is very small;

6 change your mind, Lord, over this. And this will certainly not happen, says the Lord.

7 Thus the Lord showed me, and behold, a man standing upon an adamantine wall, and adamant in his hand.

8 And the Lord said to me: What do you see, Amos? And I said: Adamant. And the Lord said to me: Behold, I place adamant in the midst of my people Israel; I will certainly no longer pass him by;

9 and altars of laughter will disappear, and the rites of Israel will be laid waste, and I will rise against the house of Ieroboam with a sword.

10 And Amasias the priest of Baithel sent to Ieroboam king of Israel, saying: Amos is making conspiracies against you in the midst of the house of Israel; the land will certainly not be able to endure all his words;

11 for thus says Amos: Ieroboam will die by a sword, but Israel will be led captive from his land.

12 And Amasias said to Amos: Seer, go, withdraw into the land of Iouda, and live there, and there you will prophesy;

13 but in Baithel you shall certainly no longer prophesy, because it is a king's sanctuary and a house of a kingdom.

14 And Amos answered and said to Amasias: I was not a prophet, nor a prophet's son, but I was a goatherd and one scratching mulberries;

15 and the Lord took me up from the sheep, and the Lord said to me: Go, prophesy against my people Israel.

16 And now hear a word of the Lord: You say: Do not prophesy against Israel, and you shall certainly not address a crowd against the house of Iakob;

17 therefore thus says the Lord: Your wife will prostitute herself in the city, and your sons and your daughters will fall by a sword, and your land will be measured out with a cord, and you will die in an unclean land, but Israel will be led captive from his land.

Chapter 8

1 Thus the Lord showed me, and behold, a birdcatcher's vessel.

2 And he said: What do you see, Amos? And I said: A birdcatcher's vessel. And the Lord said to me: The end has come upon my people Israel; I will certainly no longer pass him by;

3 and the panels of the temple will howl; on that day, says the Lord, many are the fallen in every place; I will cast silence upon them.

4 Hear now these things, those wearing down a needy one in the morning and oppressing the poor from the earth,

5 those saying: When will the month pass and we trade, and the sabbaths, and we open storehouses, to make a measure small and enlarge weights and make an unjust balance,

6 to acquire the poor with silver and a lowly one in exchange for sandals, and we will trade from every kind of produce?

7 The Lord swears by the arrogance of Iakob: If he will forget all your works for strife.

8 And over these things will the earth not be troubled? And everyone dwelling in it will mourn, and consummation will rise like a river and go down like the river of Egypt.

9 And it will be on that day, says the Lord God, that the sun will set at noon, and the light will grow dark upon the earth in daytime;

10 and I will turn your feasts into mourning and all your songs into lamentation, and I will bring sackcloth upon every waist and baldness upon every head, and I will make him like mourning for a beloved one and those with him like a day of anguish.

11 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will send out famine upon the earth, not a famine of bread nor a thirst for water, but a famine of hearing a word of the Lord;

12 and waters will be shaken as far as the sea, and from the north as far as the east they will run about seeking the word of the Lord and will certainly not find it.

13 On that day the beautiful virgins and the young men will fail with thirst,

14 those swearing by the atonement of Samareia and those saying: Your god lives, Dan, and your god lives, Bersabee; and they will fall and certainly no longer rise.

Chapter 9

1 I saw the Lord standing over the altar, and he said: Strike upon the mercy seat, and the gateways will be shaken, and cut through onto the heads of all; and I will kill their remaining ones with a sword; no fleeing one among them will escape, and no one among them saving himself will be saved.

2 If they dig down into Hades, from there my hand will pull them up; and if they go up into heaven, from there I will bring them down;

3 if they hide in the summit of Karmel, from there I will search out and take them; and if they sink from my eyes into the depths of the sea, there I will command the dragon, and it will bite them;

4 and if they go into captivity before their enemies, there I will command the sword, and it will kill them; and I will fix my eyes upon them for evil things and not for good things.

5 And the Lord Lord God the Almighty, who touches the earth and shakes it, and all who dwell in it will mourn, and its consummation will rise like a river and go down like the river of Egypt;

6 who builds his ascent into heaven and establishes his promise upon the earth, who summons the water of the sea and pours it out upon the face of the earth; the Lord God the Almighty is his name.

7 Are you not like sons of Ethiopians to me, sons of Israel? says the Lord. Did I not bring Israel up from the land of Egypt, and the foreigners from Kappadokia, and the Syrians from a pit?

8 Behold, the eyes of the Lord God are upon the kingdom of the sinners, and I will remove it from the face of the earth; nevertheless, I will not completely remove the house of Iakob, says the Lord.

9 For behold, I command, and I will winnow the house of Israel among all the nations, as it is winnowed in the winnowing basket, and a fragment will certainly not fall upon the earth.

10 All sinners of my people will die by a sword, those saying: The evil things will certainly not approach or come upon us.

11 On that day I will raise the fallen tent of David and rebuild its fallen parts, and raise its demolished parts and rebuild it as in the days of the age,

12 so that the remaining ones of men and all the nations upon whom my name has been called may seek out, says the Lord God who does these things.

13 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and the threshing will overtake the grape harvest, and the grape will ripen at the sowing, and the mountains will drip sweetness, and all the hills will be grown together;

14 and I will turn back the captivity of my people Israel, and they will build the cities that have disappeared and dwell in them, and plant vineyards and drink their wine, and plant gardens and eat their fruit;

15 and I will plant them upon their land, and they will certainly no longer be pulled out from their land which I gave them, says the Lord God the Almighty.

Micah

Chapter 1

1 And a word of the Lord came to Michaias of Morasthi in the days of Ioatham and Achaz and Ezekias, kings of Iouda, concerning what he saw about Samareia and about Ierusalem.

2 Hear words, peoples, and let the earth and all who are in it pay attention, and the Lord will be among you for a testimony, the Lord from his holy house;

3 for behold, the Lord goes out from his place, and he will descend and step upon the heights of the earth,

4 and the mountains will be shaken beneath him, and the valleys will melt like wax before fire and like water carried down a descent.

5 All these things are because of the impiety of Iakob and because of the sin of the house of Israel. What is the impiety of Iakob? Is it not Samareia? And what is the sin of the house of Iouda? Is it not Ierusalem?

6 And I will make Samareia a fruit watchman's hut in a field and a planting of a vineyard, and I will pull her stones down into a chasm and uncover her foundations;

7 and they will cut down all her carved images and burn all her wages with fire, and I will consign all her idols to disappearance; for she gathered from wages of prostitution and amassed from wages of prostitution.

8 Because of this she will beat her breast and lament; she will go barefoot and naked; she will make a beating of the breast like that of dragons and mourning like that of daughters of sirens;

9 for her wound has prevailed, because it came as far as Iouda and reached as far as the gate of my people, as far as Ierusalem.

10 Those in Geth, do not magnify yourselves; those in Akim, do not rebuild from a house for laughter; sprinkle earth upon yourselves for your laughter.

11 Dwelling well in her cities, the one dwelling in Sennaan did not go out to mourn a house adjoining her; she will receive from you a wound of anguish.

12 Who began good things for her who dwells in pains? For evil things came down from the Lord upon the gates of Ierusalem,

13 a sound of chariots and horsemen. She who dwells in Lachis is the originator of sin for the daughter of Sion, because the impieties of Israel were found in you.

14 Therefore you will give those being sent away, as far as the inheritance of Geth, vain houses; it became empty things for the kings of Israel.

15 Until I bring the heirs to you, inheritance dwelling in Lachis, the glory of the daughter of Israel will come as far as Odollam.

16 Shave yourself and shear yourself over your delicate children; widen your widowhood like an eagle, because they were taken captive from you.

Chapter 2

1 They became those devising troubles and working evil things in their beds, and at daybreak they accomplished them, because they did not lift their hands to God;

2 and they were desiring fields and plundering orphans and oppressing houses, and plundering a man and his house, a man and his inheritance.

3 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I devise evil things against this tribe, from which you will certainly not lift your necks, and you will certainly not suddenly walk upright, because it is an evil time.

4 On that day a parable will be taken up against you, and a lament will be lamented in song, saying: With misery we have been made miserable; the portion of my people was measured out with a cord, and there was no one to prevent him from turning it away; our fields were divided.

5 Therefore you will have no one casting a cord by lot in the assembly of the Lord.

6 Do not weep with tears, nor let them shed tears over these things; for he will not put away reproaches.

7 The one saying: The house of Iakob provoked the spirit of the Lord to anger; are these his practices? Are not his words good with him, and have they not proceeded upright?

8 And formerly my people stood against him in enmity; against his peace they flayed his skin, to take away hope, a crushing of war.

9 Therefore the leaders of my people will be cast out of their houses of luxury; because of their evil practices they were thrust out; approach everlasting mountains.

10 Rise and go, because this is not your rest on account of uncleanness. You were destroyed with destruction,

11 you were pursued with no one pursuing; a spirit established a lie; it dripped for you into wine and intoxicating drink. And it will be from the drop of this people:

12 being gathered, Iakob will be gathered with all; awaiting, I will await the remaining ones of Israel; I will place their return together; like sheep in affliction, like a flock in the midst of their resting place, they will leap out from men.

13 Through the breach before them they broke through and passed through a gate and went out through it, and their king went out before them, but the Lord will lead them.

Chapter 3

1 And he will say: Hear now these things, the rulers of the house of Iakob and the remaining ones of the house of Israel. Is it not yours to know judgment?

2 Those hating good things and seeking evil things, seizing their skins from them and their flesh from their bones.

3 As they devoured the flesh of my people and flayed their skins from their bones, and crushed their bones and cut them into pieces like flesh for a cauldron and like meat for a pot,

4 so they will cry to the Lord, and he will not hear them; and he will turn his face from them at that time, because they acted wickedly in their practices against them.

5 Thus says the Lord against the prophets who lead my people astray, who bite with their teeth and proclaim peace over him, and nothing was given into their mouth, they raised war against him;

6 therefore night will be yours instead of vision, and darkness will be yours instead of divination, and the sun will set upon the prophets, and the day will grow dark upon them;

7 and those seeing dreams will be put to shame, and the diviners will be laughed at, and all of them will speak against them, because there will be no one hearing them.

8 Unless I fill up strength in the spirit of the Lord and of judgment and of power, to announce to Iakob his impieties and to Israel his sins.

9 Hear now these things, the leaders of the house of Iakob and the remaining ones of the house of Israel, who abhor judgment and distort all upright things,

10 who build Sion with bloodshed and Ierusalem with injustices;

11 her leaders judged with gifts, and her priests answered with payment, and her prophets divined with silver, and they rested upon the Lord, saying: Is not the Lord among us? Evil things will certainly not come upon us.

12 Therefore, because of you, Sion will be plowed like a field, and Ierusalem will be like a fruit watchman's hut, and the mountain of the house like a grove of a thicket.

Chapter 4

1 And in the last days the mountain of the Lord will be manifest, ready upon the summits of the mountains, and it will be raised above the hills; and peoples will hasten to it,

2 and many nations will go and say: Come, let us go up to the mountain of the Lord and to the house of the God of Iakob, and they will show us his way, and we will walk in his paths; for a law will go out from Sion, and a word of the Lord from Ierusalem.

3 And he will judge between many peoples and reprove strong nations as far as a distant land, and they will cut down their swords into plows and their spears into sickles, and nation will certainly no longer raise a sword against nation, and they will certainly no longer learn to wage war.

4 And each will rest beneath his vine and each beneath his fig tree, and there will be no one frightening them, because the mouth of the Lord Almighty spoke these things.

5 For all the peoples will go, each his own way, but we will go in the name of the Lord our God into the age and beyond.

6 On that day, says the Lord, I will gather her who has been crushed, and receive her who has been thrust out and those whom I rejected;

7 and I will make her who has been crushed a remnant, and her who has been rejected a strong nation, and the Lord will reign over them on mount Sion from now and into the age.

8 And you, parched tower of a flock, daughter of Sion, to you will come and enter the first dominion, a kingdom from Babylon for the daughter of Ierusalem.

9 And now, why did you know evil things? Did you not have a king? Or did your counsel perish, that birth pangs seized you like one giving birth?

10 Be in labor and be courageous and draw near, daughter of Sion, like one giving birth; for now you will go out from a city and encamp in a plain and come as far as Babylon; from there he will rescue you, and from there the Lord your God will redeem you from the hand of your enemies.

11 And now many nations gathered against you, those saying: We will rejoice over her, and our eyes will look upon Sion.

12 But they did not know the thought of the Lord and did not understand his counsel, that he gathered them like sheaves of a threshing floor.

13 Rise and thresh them, daughter of Sion, for I will make your horns iron and your hooves bronze, and with them you will melt down nations and grind many peoples fine, and you will dedicate their multitude to the Lord and their strength to the Lord of all the earth.

14 Now the daughter of Ephraim will be shut in with a barrier; he appointed confinement against us; with a rod they will strike the tribes of Israel upon the cheek.

Chapter 5

1 And you, Bethlehem, house of Ephratha, are very small to be among the thousands of Iouda; from you one will go out for me to be a ruler in Israel, and his goings out are from the beginning, from days of an age.

2 Therefore he will give them up until the time of one giving birth; she will give birth, and the remaining ones of their brothers will return to the sons of Israel.

3 And he will stand and see and shepherd his flock in the strength of the Lord, and they will exist in the glory of the name of the Lord their God; for now he will be magnified as far as the ends of the earth.

4 And this will be peace; when an Assyrian comes upon your land and when he steps upon your region, seven shepherds and eight bites of men will be raised against him;

5 and they will shepherd Assour with a sword and the land of Nebrod in its trench; and he will rescue from Assour when he comes upon your land and when he steps upon your boundaries.

6 And the remnant of Iakob will be among the nations in the midst of many peoples like dew falling from the Lord and like lambs upon grass, so that no one may be gathered or stand among sons of men.

7 And the remnant of Iakob will be among the nations in the midst of many peoples like a lion among beasts in the thicket and like a young lion among flocks of sheep, as when he passes through and, separating, seizes, and there is no one rescuing.

8 Your hand will be raised against those afflicting you, and all your enemies will be destroyed.

9 And it will be on that day, says the Lord, I will destroy your horses from your midst and destroy your chariots,

10 and I will destroy the cities of your land and remove all your strongholds;

11 and I will remove your sorceries from your hands, and there will be no utterers in you;

12 and I will destroy your carved images and your pillars from your midst, and you will certainly no longer bow down to the works of your hands;

13 and I will cut out your groves from your midst and make your cities disappear;

14 and I will execute vengeance in wrath and in anger among the nations, because they did not listen.

Chapter 6

1 Hear now a word of the Lord; the Lord said: Rise, plead your case before the mountains, and let the hills hear your voice.

2 Hear, hills, the judgment of the Lord, and you ravines, foundations of the earth, for the Lord has a case against his people, and he will dispute with Israel.

3 My people, what did I do to you, or how did I grieve you, or how did I trouble you? Answer me.

4 For I brought you up from the land of Egypt and redeemed you from a house of slavery, and sent out before you Moyses and Aaron and Mariam.

5 My people, remember now what Balak king of Moab planned against you, and what Balaam son of Beor answered him, from the rushes as far as Galgal, so that the righteousness of the Lord may be known.

6 With what shall I reach the Lord, shall I take hold of my God Most High? Shall I reach him with whole burnt offerings, with year-old calves?

7 Will the Lord accept with thousands of rams or with myriads of fat torrents? Shall I give my firstborn for impiety, the fruit of my womb for the sin of my soul?

8 Was it announced to you, man, what is good? Or what does the Lord seek from you except to do judgment and love mercy and be ready to walk with the Lord your God?

9 A voice of the Lord will be called to the city, and he will save those fearing his name. Hear, tribe, and who will adorn a city?

10 Is there not fire and a house of a lawless one treasuring lawless treasures, and injustice with arrogance?

11 Will a lawless one be justified with a balance, and weights of deceit in a purse?

12 From which they filled their wealth with impiety, and those dwelling in it were speaking false things, and their tongue was raised in their mouth.

13 And I will begin to strike you; I will make you disappear on account of your sins.

14 You will eat and certainly not be filled; and it will grow dark within you and turn aside, and you will certainly not be saved; and as many as are saved will be handed over to a sword.

15 You will sow and certainly not reap; you will press olives and certainly not anoint with oil, and wine, and you will certainly not drink, and the ordinances of my people will disappear.

16 And you kept the statutes of Zambri and all the works of the house of Achaab, and you walked in their counsels, so that I may hand you over to disappearance and those dwelling in it to hissing; and you will receive reproaches of peoples.

Chapter 7

1 Alas for me, for I became like one gathering straw at harvest and like a grape gleaning at vintage, with no cluster existing to eat the first fruits. Alas, soul,

2 for a devout one has perished from the earth, and one acting uprightly does not exist among men; all plead for bloodshed; each presses out his neighbor with a pressing out.

3 They prepare their hands for evil; the ruler asks, and the judge spoke peaceful words; it is according to the desire of his soul. And I will remove

4 their good things like a moth eating away and walking upon a measuring rod on a day of watching. Woe, woe, your punishments have come; now there will be their weepings.

5 Do not put trust in friends and do not place hope in leaders; guard yourself against your bedmate, from entrusting anything to her;

6 for a son dishonors a father, a daughter will rise against her mother, a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law; a man's enemies are all the men in his house.

7 But I will look to the Lord; I will wait for God my savior; my God will hear me.

8 Do not rejoice over me, my enemy, because I have fallen; and I will rise, for if I sit in darkness, the Lord will give me light.

9 I will bear the wrath of the Lord, because I sinned against him, until he vindicates my case; and he will execute my judgment and bring me out into the light; I will see his righteousness.

10 And my enemy will see and clothe herself in shame, she who says to me: Where is the Lord your God? My eyes will look upon her; now she will be for trampling like mud in the streets

11 of a day of brick plastering. That day is your erasure, and it will rub away your ordinances,

12 that day; and your cities will come to leveling and to division among Assyrians, and your fortified cities to division from Tyre as far as the river of Syria, a day of water and tumult;

13 and the land will be consigned to disappearance together with those dwelling in it, from the fruits of their practices.

14 Shepherd your people with your rod, sheep of your inheritance, those encamping by themselves in a thicket in the midst of Karmel; they will graze in Basanitis and Galaaditis as in the days of the age.

15 And according to the days of your departure from Egypt, you will see astonishing things.

16 Nations will see and be put to shame for all their strength; they will place hands upon their mouth; their ears will be deafened.

17 They will lick dust like serpents dragging along the earth; they will be confounded in their confinement; they will be astounded at the Lord our God and fear you.

18 Who is a God like you? Removing injustices and passing over impieties for the remaining ones of his inheritance, and he did not retain his wrath for a testimony, because he is one desiring mercy.

19 He will turn and have compassion on us; he will sink our injustices, and they will be cast away into the depths of the sea, all our sins.

20 You will give truth to Iakob, mercy to Abraam, as you swore to our fathers in the former days.

Joel

Chapter 1

1 A word of the Lord, which came to Ioel son of Bathouel.

2 Hear now these things, elders, and give ear, all who dwell in the land. Have such things happened in your days or in the days of your fathers?

3 Tell your children about them, and your children their children, and their children another generation.

4 The locust devoured what remained of the caterpillar, and the locust grub devoured what remained of the locust, and the mildew devoured what remained of the locust grub.

5 Sober up from their wine, you who are drunk, and weep; lament, all who drink wine to drunkenness, because gladness and joy have been removed from your mouth.

6 For a nation came up upon my land, strong and innumerable; its teeth are a lion's teeth, and its molars those of a young lion;

7 it consigned my vine to disappearance and my fig trees to breaking; searching, it searched her out and cast her away; it whitened her branches.

8 Lament to me more than a bride girded with sackcloth over the husband of her virginity.

9 Sacrifice and libation have been removed from the house of the Lord. Mourn, priests who minister at the altar,

10 for the plains have suffered misery; let the earth mourn, for grain has suffered misery, wine dried up, oil diminished.

11 The farmers dried up; lament, estates, over wheat and barley, because the harvest has perished from the field;

12 the vine dried up, and the fig trees diminished; pomegranate and palm and apple tree and all the trees of the field dried up, because the sons of men put joy to shame.

13 Gird yourselves and beat your breasts, priests; lament, those ministering at the altar; enter, sleep in sackcloth, those ministering to God, because sacrifice and libation have withdrawn from the house of your God.

14 Sanctify a fast, proclaim a service, gather elders, all who dwell in the land, into the house of your God, and cry earnestly to the Lord:

15 Alas, alas, alas for the day, because the day of the Lord is near, and it will come like misery out of misery.

16 Before your eyes food was destroyed, gladness and joy from the house of your God.

17 Heifers leaped at their mangers; storehouses disappeared; winepresses were torn down, because grain dried up.

18 What shall we store up for ourselves? Herds of cattle wept because there was no pasture for them, and the flocks of sheep disappeared.

19 To you, Lord, I will cry, because fire consumed the beautiful things of the wilderness, and a flame kindled all the trees of the field;

20 and the beasts of the plain looked up to you, because outlets of waters dried up, and fire devoured the beautiful things of the wilderness.

Chapter 2

1 Sound a trumpet in Sion, proclaim on my holy mountain, and let all who dwell in the land be confounded, because the day of the Lord is present, because it is near,

2 a day of darkness and gloom, a day of cloud and mist. Like dawn, a numerous and strong people will be poured upon the mountains; its like has not come to be from the age, and after it none will be added for years into generations of generations.

3 Before it, a consuming fire, and behind it, a kindled flame; the land before it is like a paradise of delight, and behind it a plain of disappearance, and it will have no survivor.

4 Their appearance is like the sight of horses, and like horsemen, so they will pursue;

5 like the sound of chariots they will leap upon the summits of the mountains, and like the sound of a flame of fire devouring straw, and like a numerous and strong people drawn up for war.

6 Before it peoples will be crushed; every face is like the scorching of a pot.

7 Like fighters they will run, and like warrior men they will climb upon the walls, and each will go in his way, and they will certainly not turn aside their paths,

8 and each will not keep away from his brother; weighed down with their weapons, they will go and fall among their missiles and certainly not be brought to an end.

9 They will take hold of the city and run upon the walls and climb upon the houses and enter through windows like thieves.

10 Before them the earth will be confounded and heaven shaken; the sun and the moon will grow dark, and the stars will cause their brightness to set.

11 And the Lord will give his voice before his force, because his camp is exceedingly numerous, because the works of his words are strong; for the day of the Lord is great, great and exceedingly manifest, and who will be sufficient for it?

12 And now the Lord your God says: Return to me with your whole heart and with fasting and with weeping and with beating of the breast;

13 and tear your hearts and not your garments, and return to the Lord your God, because he is merciful and compassionate, long-suffering and abundant in mercy, and changes his mind over evil things.

14 Who knows whether he will turn and change his mind and leave behind him a blessing, a sacrifice and a libation to the Lord our God?

15 Sound a trumpet in Sion, sanctify a fast, proclaim a service,

16 gather a people, sanctify an assembly, choose elders, gather infants sucking breasts; let a bridegroom go out from his bedroom and a bride from her bridal chamber.

17 In the midst of the base of the altar the priests ministering to the Lord will weep and say: Spare, Lord, your people, and do not give your inheritance to reproach, for nations to rule them, so that they may not say among the nations: Where is their God?

18 And the Lord was zealous for his land and spared his people.

19 And the Lord answered and said to his people: Behold, I send out to you grain and wine and oil, and you will be filled with them, and I will no longer give you to reproach among the nations;

20 and I will drive away from you the one from the north, and thrust him into a waterless land, and make his front disappear into the first sea and his rear into the last sea; and his decay will rise, and his stench will rise, because he magnified his works.

21 Take courage, earth, rejoice and be glad, because the Lord magnified his doing.

22 Take courage, beasts of the plain, because plains of the wilderness have sprouted, because a tree bore its fruit; vine and fig tree gave their strength.

23 And children of Sion, rejoice and be glad in the Lord your God, because he gave you food for righteousness, and he will rain upon you early and late rain as before,

24 and the threshing floors will be filled with grain, and the winepresses will overflow with wine and oil.

25 And I will repay you for the years which the locust and the locust grub and the mildew and the caterpillar devoured, my great force which I sent out among you;

26 and eating, you will eat and be filled, and praise the name of the Lord your God, for what he did with you as wonders, and my people will certainly not be put to shame into the age;

27 and you will know that I am in the midst of Israel, and I am the Lord your God, and there is no other except me, and all my people will certainly no longer be put to shame into the age.

Chapter 3

1 And it will be after these things that I will pour out from my spirit upon all flesh, and your sons and your daughters will prophesy, and your elders will dream dreams, and your young men will see visions;

2 and upon the male slaves and upon the female slaves in those days I will pour out from my spirit.

3 And I will give portents in heaven and upon the earth, blood and fire and vapor of smoke;

4 the sun will be turned into darkness and the moon into blood before the great and manifest day of the Lord comes.

5 And it will be that everyone who calls upon the name of the Lord will be saved; for on mount Sion and in Ierusalem there will be a survivor, as the Lord said, and those announcing good news whom the Lord has called.

Chapter 4

1 For behold, I, in those days and at that time, when I turn back the captivity of Iouda and Ierusalem,

2 will also gather all the nations and bring them down into the valley of Iosaphat, and I will plead against them there on behalf of my people and my inheritance Israel, who were scattered among the nations; and they divided up my land,

3 and cast lots for my people, and gave the boys to prostitutes and were selling the girls in exchange for wine, and drinking.

4 And what are you also to me, Tyre and Sidon and all Galilaia of the foreigners? Are you repaying me a recompense? Or do you bear a sharp grudge against me? And quickly I will repay your recompense upon your heads,

5 because you took my silver and my gold and brought my choice things and beautiful things into your temples,

6 and sold the sons of Iouda and the sons of Ierusalem to the sons of the Greeks, so that you might thrust them out of their boundaries.

7 Behold, I rouse them from the place where you sold them, and I will repay your recompense upon your heads,

8 and sell your sons and your daughters into the hands of sons of Iouda, and they will sell them into captivity to a nation far away, because the Lord spoke.

9 Proclaim these things among the nations, sanctify war, rouse the fighters; bring them forward and go up, all warrior men.

10 Beat your plows into swords and your sickles into lances; let the powerless one say: I am strong.

11 Gather and enter, all the nations round about, and be gathered there; let the meek one be a fighter.

12 Let all the nations be roused and go up into the valley of Iosaphat, for there I will sit to judge all the nations round about.

13 Send out sickles, because the harvest is present; enter, tread, because the winepress is full; the vats overflow, because their evil things have multiplied.

14 Sounds resounded in the valley of judgment, because the day of the Lord is near in the valley of judgment.

15 The sun and the moon will grow dark, and the stars will cause their brightness to set.

16 But the Lord will cry out from Sion and give his voice from Ierusalem, and heaven and earth will be shaken; but the Lord will spare his people, and the Lord will strengthen the sons of Israel.

17 And you will know that I am the Lord your God who dwells in Sion on my holy mountain; and Ierusalem will be a holy city, and foreigners will no longer pass through her.

18 And it will be on that day that the mountains will drip sweetness, and the hills will flow with milk, and all the outlets of Iouda will flow with waters, and a spring will go out from the house of the Lord and water the torrent of the rushes.

19 Egypt will be consigned to disappearance, and Idoumaia will be a plain of disappearance because of injustices against sons of Iouda, because they poured out righteous blood in their land.

20 But Ioudaia will be inhabited into the age, and Ierusalem into generations of generations.

21 And I will avenge their blood and certainly not acquit. And the Lord will dwell in Sion.

Obadiah

Chapter 1

1 A vision of Abdias. Thus says the Lord God to Idoumaia: I heard a report from the Lord, and he sent out a dispatch to the nations: Rise, and let us rise up against her for war.

2 Behold, I have made you very small among the nations; you are exceedingly dishonored.

3 The arrogance of your heart lifted you up, dwelling in the openings of the rocks, raising his dwelling, saying in his heart: Who will bring me down to the earth?

4 If you are raised aloft like an eagle, and if you place your nest among the stars, from there I will bring you down, says the Lord.

5 If thieves entered to you, or robbers by night, where would you have been cast away? Would they not have stolen what was sufficient for themselves? And if grape harvesters entered to you, would they not have left a gleaning?

6 How Esau was searched out, and his hidden things seized.

7 All the men of your covenant sent you out as far as your boundaries; your men of peace opposed you, prevailed against you; they placed ambushes beneath you; there is no understanding in them.

8 On that day, says the Lord, I will destroy wise men from Idoumaia and understanding from the mountain of Esau;

9 and your fighters from Thaiman will be terrified, so that a man may be removed from the mountain of Esau

10 because of the slaughter and the impiety against your brother Iakob, and shame will cover you, and you will be removed into the age.

11 From the day you stood opposed, on a day when foreigners were taking his force captive, and strangers entered his gates and cast lots over Ierusalem, you too were like one of them.

12 And do not look upon your brother's day on a day of strangers, and do not rejoice over the sons of Iouda on the day of their destruction, and do not speak boastfully on a day of affliction;

13 nor enter the gates of peoples on the day of their troubles, nor yourself look upon their gathering on the day of their ruin, nor join in attacking their force on the day of their destruction;

14 nor stand over their passageways to destroy their survivors, nor shut in those fleeing from them on a day of affliction.

15 For the day of the Lord is near upon all the nations; as you did, so it will be for you; your recompense will be repaid upon your head;

16 for as you drank upon my holy mountain, all the nations will drink wine; they will drink and go down, and they will be as though not existing.

17 But on mount Sion there will be salvation, and it will be holy; and the house of Iakob will inherit those who inherited them.

18 And the house of Iakob will be fire, but the house of Ioseph a flame, and the house of Esau straw, and they will blaze against them and devour them, and there will be no fire-bearer in the house of Esau, because the Lord spoke.

19 And those in Nageb will inherit the mountain of Esau, and those in Sephela the foreigners, and they will inherit the mountain of Ephraim and the plain of Samareia and Beniamin and Galaaditis.

20 And this is the beginning of the resettlement: for the sons of Israel, the land of the Chananites as far as Sarepta, and the resettlement of Ierusalem as far as Ephratha, and they will inherit the cities of Nageb.

21 And saved men will go up from mount Sion to punish the mountain of Esau, and the kingdom will belong to the Lord.

Jonah

Chapter 1

1 And a word of the Lord came to Ionas son of Amathi, saying:

2 Rise and go to Nineue, the great city, and proclaim in it, because the cry of its wickedness came up to me.

3 And Ionas rose to flee to Tharsis from the presence of the Lord, and went down to Ioppe and found a ship going to Tharsis, and paid its fare and boarded it to sail with them to Tharsis from the presence of the Lord.

4 And the Lord stirred up a wind upon the sea, and a great surge arose in the sea, and the ship was in danger of being shattered.

5 And the sailors feared and were crying out, each to their god, and cast the equipment in the ship into the sea to be lightened of it; but Ionas went down into the hollow of the ship and was sleeping and snoring.

6 And the lookout approached him and said to him: Why are you snoring? Rise and call upon your god, so that God may save us and we may not perish.

7 And each said to his neighbor: Come, let us cast lots and learn on whose account this evil is among us. And they cast lots, and the lot fell upon Ionas.

8 And they said to him: Tell us on whose account this evil is among us. What is your work? And from where do you come, and from what region and what people are you?

9 And he said to them: I am a slave of the Lord, and I worship the Lord God of heaven, who made the sea and the dry land.

10 And the men feared a great fear and said to him: What is this you have done? For the men knew that he was fleeing from the presence of the Lord, because he told them.

11 And they said to him: What shall we do to you, and the sea will abate from us? For the sea was continuing and stirring up a greater surge.

12 And Ionas said to them: Lift me and cast me into the sea, and the sea will abate from you; for I know that this great surge is upon you because of me.

13 And the men were forcing themselves to return to the land and could not, because the sea was continuing and being stirred up more against them.

14 And they cried out to the Lord and said: By no means, Lord, let us not perish on account of this man's soul, and do not place righteous blood upon us, because you, Lord, have done as you wished.

15 And they took Ionas and cast him out into the sea, and the sea ceased from its tossing.

16 And the men feared the Lord with great fear, and sacrificed a sacrifice to the Lord and vowed vows.

Chapter 2

1 And the Lord commanded a great sea creature to swallow Ionas; and Ionas was in the belly of the sea creature three days and three nights.

2 And Ionas prayed to the Lord his God from the belly of the sea creature,

3 and said: I cried in my affliction to the Lord my God, and he heard me; from the belly of Hades, of my cry, you heard my voice.

4 You cast me away into the depths of the heart of the sea, and rivers surrounded me; all your billows and your waves passed over me.

5 And I said: I have been rejected from your eyes; shall I again look toward your holy temple?

6 Water poured around me as far as my soul; the utmost abyss surrounded me; my head sank into clefts of mountains.

7 I went down into a land whose bars are everlasting restraints, and let the corruption of my life rise up, Lord my God.

8 When my soul was failing from me, I remembered the Lord, and may my prayer come to you into your holy temple.

9 Those guarding vain and false things abandoned their mercy.

10 But I will sacrifice to you with a voice of praise and confession; whatever I vowed, I will repay to you, of salvation to the Lord.

11 And the sea creature was commanded, and it cast Ionas out upon the dry land.

Chapter 3

1 And a word of the Lord came to Ionas a second time, saying:

2 Rise and go to Nineue, the great city, and proclaim in it according to the former proclamation which I spoke to you.

3 And Ionas rose and went to Nineue, as the Lord spoke; but Nineue was a city great to God, about a journey of three days' road.

4 And Ionas began to enter the city about a day's journey, and proclaimed and said: Yet three days, and Nineue will be overturned.

5 And the men of Nineue believed God and proclaimed a fast and put on sackcloth, from their great to their small.

6 And the word reached the king of Nineue, and he rose from his throne and removed his robe from himself and clothed himself in sackcloth and sat upon ashes.

7 And it was proclaimed and said in Nineue by the king and by his grandees, saying: Let men and beasts and cattle and sheep taste nothing, nor graze, nor drink water.

8 And the men and the beasts clothed themselves in sackcloth and cried earnestly to God; and each turned from his evil way and from the injustice in their hands, saying:

9 Who knows whether God will change his mind and turn from the wrath of his anger, and we will certainly not perish?

10 And God saw their works, that they turned from their evil ways, and God changed his mind over the evil which he spoke of doing to them, and did not do it.

Chapter 4

1 And Ionas was grieved with great grief and was confounded.

2 And he prayed to the Lord and said: O Lord, were these not my words while I was still in my land? Therefore I made haste to flee to Tharsis, for I knew that you are merciful and compassionate, long-suffering and abundant in mercy, and change your mind over evil things.

3 And now, Master Lord, take my soul from me, because it is better for me to die than for me to live.

4 And the Lord said to Ionas: Have you been exceedingly grieved?

5 And Ionas went out from the city and sat opposite the city; and he made himself a tent there and was sitting beneath it in shade, until he should see what would happen to the city.

6 And the Lord God commanded a gourd, and it rose above the head of Ionas to be shade above his head, to shade him from his evils; and Ionas rejoiced over the gourd with great joy.

7 And God commanded a worm at dawn the next day, and it struck the gourd, and it dried up.

8 And it happened as the sun rose that God commanded a scorching wind of burning heat, and the sun struck upon the head of Ionas; and he grew faint and was renouncing his soul, and said: It is better for me to die than to live.

9 And God said to Ionas: Have you been exceedingly grieved over the gourd? And he said: I have been exceedingly grieved unto death.

10 And the Lord said: You had pity on the gourd, for which you suffered no hardship and which you did not nourish, which came to be in a night and perished in a night.

11 But shall I not have pity on Nineue, the great city, in which dwell more than twelve myriads of men, who did not know their right hand or their left hand, and many beasts?

Nahum

Chapter 1

1 An oracle of Nineue; a book of the vision of Naoum the Elkesite.

2 A jealous God and an avenger is the Lord, the Lord avenging with anger, the Lord avenging his adversaries, and he himself removing his enemies.

3 The Lord is long-suffering, and his strength is great, and acquitting, the Lord will not acquit. His way is in consummation and shaking together, and clouds are the dust of his feet.

4 Threatening the sea and drying it, and laying waste all the rivers; Basanitis and Karmel diminished, and the blossoming things of Lebanon failed.

5 The mountains were shaken by him, and the hills were moved; and the earth recoiled before him, the whole earth and all who dwell in it.

6 Who will stand before his wrath? And who will resist in the wrath of his anger? His anger melts dominions, and the rocks were shattered by him.

7 The Lord is kind to those awaiting him on a day of affliction, and knows those revering him;

8 and in a flood in its course he will make an end of those rising up, and darkness will pursue his enemies.

9 What do you devise against the Lord? He himself will make an end; he will not punish twice for the same thing with affliction;

10 for it will be laid barren as far as their foundation, and consumed like an entwined bindweed and like straw full of dryness.

11 From you will go out a thought against the Lord, devising evil things in opposition.

12 Thus says the Lord who rules many waters: And thus they will be separated, and your report will no longer be heard.

13 And now I will shatter his rod from you and tear your bonds;

14 and the Lord will command concerning you; no longer will anything be sown from your name; from the house of your god I will destroy the carved and cast images; I will appoint your burial, because you are swift.

Chapter 2

1 Behold, upon the mountains the feet of one announcing good news and reporting peace; celebrate your feasts, Iouda, repay your vows, because they will certainly no longer pass through you unto old age. It has been brought to an end, removed.

2 One blowing into your face went up, rescuing from affliction; watch a road, strengthen your waist, be exceedingly courageous in strength,

3 for the Lord turned away the arrogance of Iakob as the arrogance of Israel, because shaking out, they shook them out and their branches; they destroyed

4 the weapons of their power from men, mighty men mocking amid fire; the reins of their chariots on the day of his preparation, and the horsemen will be disturbed

5 in the roads, and the chariots will be confounded and entangled in the squares; their appearance is like torches of fire and like lightning running through.

6 And their grandees will remember and flee by day and grow weak in their journey and hasten to the walls and prepare their outposts.

7 The gates of the rivers were opened, and the palaces collapsed,

8 and the foundation was uncovered, and she was going up, and her female slaves were being led, like doves uttering in their hearts.

9 And Nineue, her waters are like a pool of water, and they, fleeing, did not stop, and there was no one looking back.

10 They were plundering silver, plundering gold, and there was no end to her adornment; they have been weighed down beyond all her desirable vessels.

11 A shaking out and a shaking up and a boiling out and a breaking of heart and a loosening of knees and birth pangs upon every waist, and the face of all like the scorching of a pot.

12 Where is the dwelling place of the lions and the pasture belonging to the young lions, where a lion went to enter there, a young lion, and there was no one frightening it?

13 A lion seized what was sufficient for his young lions and strangled for his lions, and filled his nest with prey and his dwelling with plunder.

14 Behold, I am against you, says the Lord Almighty, and I will burn your multitude into smoke, and a sword will devour your lions, and I will destroy your prey from the earth, and your works will certainly no longer be heard.

Chapter 3

1 O city of bloodshed, wholly false, full of injustice; prey will not be felt for.

2 A sound of whips and a sound of the shaking of wheels and of a horse pursuing and of a chariot bounding,

3 and of a horseman mounting and of a glittering sword and of flashing weapons and of a multitude of wounded and of a heavy fall; and there was no end to her nations, and they will grow weak among their bodies

4 from the multitude of prostitution. A beautiful and pleasing prostitute, a mistress of sorceries, who sells nations through her prostitution and tribes through her sorceries,

5 behold, I am against you, says the Lord God the Almighty, and I will uncover your rear over your face and show nations your shame and kingdoms your dishonor,

6 and cast abomination upon you according to your uncleannesses and make you an example,

7 and it will be that everyone seeing you will leap away from you and say: Wretched Nineue; who will lament her? From where shall I seek consolation for her?

8 Prepare a portion, fit a string, prepare a portion, Amon who dwells among rivers, water round about her, whose dominion is the sea and whose walls are water,

9 and Ethiopia is her strength, and Egypt, and there is no end to flight, and Libyans became her helpers.

10 And she will go captive into resettlement, and they will dash her infants to the ground at the beginnings of all her roads, and cast lots for all her glorious things, and all her grandees will be bound with hand fetters.

11 And you will be made drunk and be disregarded, and you will seek for yourself a stand against enemies.

12 All your strongholds are fig trees having watchmen; if they are shaken, they too will fall into the mouth of one eating.

13 Behold, your people are like women within you; opening, the gates of your land will be opened to your enemies, and fire will devour your bars.

14 Draw water for a siege for yourself and hold fast your strongholds; step into clay and be trampled together in straw; hold fast for brick;

15 there fire will devour you, a sword will destroy you, it will devour you like a locust, and you will be weighed down like a locust grub.

16 You multiplied your trades beyond the stars of heaven; a locust grub rushed and spread its wings.

17 Your mixed multitude leaped out like a grasshopper, like a locust mounted upon a hedge on days of frost; the sun rose, and it leaped away, and he did not know her place; woe to them.

18 Your shepherds grew drowsy; an Assyrian king put your potentates to sleep; your people departed to the mountains, and there was no one receiving them.

19 There is no healing for your crushing; your wound became inflamed; all who hear your report will clap hands over you; for upon whom has your wickedness not come continually?

Habakkuk

Chapter 1

1 The oracle which Ambakoum the prophet saw.

2 How long, Lord, will I cry and you certainly not hear? Will I cry to you, being wronged, and you not save?

3 Why did you show me troubles and pains, to look upon misery and impiety? Judgment has arisen against me, and the judge takes.

4 Therefore law has been dispersed, and judgment is not carried through to completion, because the impious one oppresses the righteous one; because of this judgment will go out distorted.

5 See, despisers, and look and marvel at wonders and disappear, because I work a work in your days which you will certainly not believe if someone recounts it.

6 For behold, I rouse against you the Chaldeans, the fighters, the bitter and swift nation going over the breadths of the earth to inherit dwellings not its own;

7 he is fearsome and manifest; his judgment will be from himself, and his oracle will go out from himself;

8 and his horses will leap beyond leopards and are swifter than the wolves of Arabia; and his horsemen will ride out and rush from afar and fly like an eagle eager to eat.

9 An end will come to the impious who stand opposed to their faces, and he will gather captivity like sand.

10 And he will revel among kings, and tyrants are his playthings, and he will mock every stronghold and throw up a mound and seize it.

11 Then the spirit will change and pass through and make atonement; this strength belongs to my God. –

12 Are you not from the beginning, Lord, my holy God? And we will certainly not die. Lord, you have appointed him for judgment; and he formed me to reprove his discipline.

13 The eye is pure so as not to see evil things, and you will not be able to look upon pains; why do you look upon despisers? Will you remain silent when an impious one swallows the righteous one?

14 And you will make men like the fish of the sea and like the creeping things having no leader.

15 He pulled up an entirety with a hook and dragged him in a casting net and gathered him in his drag nets; because of this his heart will be glad and rejoice;

16 because of this he will sacrifice to his drag net and burn incense to his casting net, because with them he fattened his portion, and his food is choice;

17 therefore he will cast his casting net and will not spare to kill nations continually.

Chapter 2

1 I will stand upon my watch and step upon a rock, and look out to see what he will speak in me and what I will answer concerning my reproof.

2 And the Lord answered me and said: Write a vision, and clearly upon a tablet, so that the one reading these things may run.

3 For the vision is still for an appointed time, and it will rise toward an end and not in vain; if he is late, await him, because coming, he will come and certainly not delay.

4 If he draws back, my soul takes no pleasure in him; but the righteous one will live by my faith.

5 But the wine-soaked and contemptuous man, a boaster, will certainly accomplish nothing, who widened his soul like Hades, and he, like death, is not filled, and he will gather all the nations to himself and receive all the peoples to himself.

6 Will not all these take up a parable against him and a riddle for his narration? And they will say: Woe to the one multiplying for himself what is not his – how long? – and heavily weighing down his collar.

7 For suddenly those biting him will rise, and your plotters will sober up, and you will become plunder for them.

8 Because you despoiled many nations, all the remaining peoples will despoil you because of bloodshed of men and impieties of land and city and all who dwell in it. –

9 O one gaining an evil gain for his house, to place his nest on high, to be pulled out from the hand of evil things.

10 You planned shame for your house; you brought many peoples to an end, and your soul sinned;

11 for a stone will cry from a wall, and a beetle from wood will utter these things. –

12 Woe to the one building a city with bloodshed and preparing a city with injustices.

13 Are these things not from the Lord Almighty? And considerable peoples failed in fire, and many nations grew faint.

14 For the earth will be filled with knowing the glory of the Lord; like water it will cover them. –

15 O one giving his neighbor drink with a turbid overthrow and making him drunk, so that he may look upon their caves.

16 Drink, you too, a fullness of dishonor instead of glory, and be moved and shaken; the cup of the Lord's right hand came round upon you, and dishonor gathered upon your glory.

17 For the impiety of Lebanon will cover you, and the misery of beasts will terrify you because of bloodshed of men and impieties of land and city and all who dwell in it. –

18 What does a carved image profit, that they carved it? They formed it as a cast image, a false apparition, because the one forming it trusts in his formation to make mute idols.

19 Woe to the one saying to wood: Sober up, be roused, and to stone: Be raised; and it is an apparition; this is a plate of gold and silver, and there is no spirit at all in it.

20 But the Lord is in his holy temple; let all the earth revere before him.

Chapter 3

1 A prayer of Ambakoum the prophet with a song.

2 Lord, I have heard your report and feared; I considered your works and was astounded. In the midst of two living creatures you will be known; as the years approach you will be recognized; when the time is present you will be shown forth; when my soul is troubled, in wrath you will remember mercy.

3 God will come from Thaiman, and the holy one from a densely wooded, shaded mountain. Musical interlude. His excellence covered heavens, and the earth is full of his praise.

4 And his brightness will be like light, horns in his hands, and he appointed a mighty love of his strength.

5 A word will go before him, and he will go out, his feet in sandals.

6 He stood, and the earth was moved; he looked, and nations melted. The mountains were shattered violently; everlasting hills melted.

7 I saw his everlasting journeys in place of troubles; dwellings of Ethiopians will be terrified, and the tents of the land of Madiam.

8 Were you angry with rivers, Lord, or was your anger against rivers, or your impulse against the sea? For you will mount your horses, and your riding is salvation.

9 Stretching, you will stretch your bow against the scepters, says the Lord. Musical interlude. The earth will be broken by rivers.

10 Peoples will see you and be in labor, scattering waters of his course; the abyss gave her voice, the height of her apparition.

11 The sun was raised, and the moon stood in her station; your missiles will go into light, into the brightness of the lightning of your weapons.

12 With a threat you will diminish the earth, and in anger bring down nations.

13 You went out for the salvation of your people, to save your anointed ones; you cast death upon the heads of lawless ones; you raised bonds as far as the neck. Musical interlude.

14 In astonishment you cut through heads of potentates; they will be shaken in it; they will open their bridles like a poor one eating secretly.

15 And you brought your horses into the sea, troubling much water.

16 I guarded myself, and my belly was terrified at the sound of the prayer of my lips, and trembling entered my bones, and beneath me my condition was troubled. I will rest on a day of affliction, to go up to the people of my sojourning.

17 For a fig tree will not bear fruit, and there will be no produce in the vines; the work of an olive tree will prove false, and the plains will not produce food; sheep failed for lack of food, and cattle do not exist at mangers.

18 But I will exult in the Lord, rejoice in God my savior.

19 The Lord God is my strength and will appoint my feet for completion; he brings me up upon the high places, to conquer in his song.

Zephaniah

Chapter 1

1 A word of the Lord which came to Sophonias son of Chousi, son of Godolias, son of Amarias, son of Ezekias, in the days of Iosias son of Amon, king of Iouda.

2 With a failing let all things fail from the face of the earth, says the Lord,

3 let man and beasts fail, let the birds of heaven and the fish of the sea fail, and I will remove men from the face of the earth, says the Lord.

4 And I will stretch my hand against Iouda and against all who dwell in Ierusalem, and remove from this place the names of Baal and the names of the priests,

5 and those bowing down on the rooftops to the army of heaven, and those swearing by the Lord and those swearing by their king,

6 and those turning aside from the Lord and those who did not seek the Lord and those not holding fast to the Lord.

7 Revere before the Lord God, because the day of the Lord is near, because the Lord has prepared his sacrifice, has sanctified his invited ones.

8 And it will be on the day of the Lord's sacrifice that I will punish the rulers and the house of the king and all those clothed in foreign garments;

9 and on that day I will punish all openly at the gateways, those filling the house of the Lord their God with impiety and deceit.

10 And on that day, says the Lord, there will be a sound of a cry from the gate of those piercing, and a howl from the second, and a great crushing from the hills.

11 Lament, those dwelling in the cut-down place, because all the people of Chanaan were made alike; all those lifted up with silver were destroyed.

12 And on that day I will search Ierusalem with a lamp and punish the men who despise upon their guarded stores, those saying in their hearts: The Lord will certainly not do good or do harm,

13 and their force will become plunder and their houses disappearance, and they will build houses and certainly not dwell in them, and plant vineyards and certainly not drink their wine.

14 For the great day of the Lord is near, near and exceedingly swift; the sound of the day of the Lord is bitter and harsh; it has been appointed mighty.

15 That day is a day of wrath, a day of affliction and necessity, a day of untimeliness and disappearance, a day of darkness and gloom, a day of cloud and mist,

16 a day of trumpet and shouting against the fortified cities and against the high corners.

17 And I will press men hard, and they will walk like blind men, because they sinned against the Lord; and he will pour out their blood like dust and their flesh like dung.

18 And their silver and their gold will certainly not be able to rescue them on the day of the Lord's wrath, and all the earth will be consumed in the fire of his jealousy, because he will bring an end and haste upon all who dwell in the earth.

Chapter 2

1 Gather and be bound together, undisciplined nation,

2 before you become like a flower passing away, before the wrath of the Lord comes upon you, before the day of the Lord's anger comes upon you.

3 Seek the Lord, all lowly ones of the earth; work judgment and seek righteousness and answer these things, so that you may be sheltered on the day of the Lord's wrath.

4 For Gaza will be plundered, and Askalon will be consigned to disappearance, and Azotos will be cast out at noon, and Akkaron uprooted.

5 Woe to those dwelling in the measured portion of the sea, sojourners of Cretans; a word of the Lord is against you, Chanaan, land of foreigners, and I will destroy you from habitation;

6 and Crete will be pasture for flocks and an enclosure for sheep,

7 and the measured portion of the sea will belong to the remaining ones of the house of Iouda; they will graze upon them in the houses of Askalon; at evening they will lodge away from the presence of the sons of Iouda, because the Lord their God has visited them and turned back their captivity.

8 I heard reproaches of Moab and blows of the fists of the sons of Ammon, with which they were reproaching my people and magnifying themselves against my boundaries.

9 Therefore, I live, says the Lord of forces, the God of Israel, for Moab will be like Sodoma and the sons of Ammon like Gomorra, and Damascus abandoned like a heap on a threshing floor and made to disappear into the age; and the remaining ones of my people plunder them, and the remaining ones of my nation will inherit them.

10 This is for them in exchange for their arrogance, because they reproached and magnified themselves against the Lord Almighty.

11 The Lord will appear against them and destroy all the gods of the nations of the earth, and they will bow down to him, each from his place, all the islands of the nations.

12 And you, Ethiopians, are wounded by my sword.

13 And he will stretch his hand against the north and destroy the Assyrian and make Nineue a waterless disappearance like a wilderness;

14 and flocks and all the beasts of the earth will graze in her midst, and chameleons and hedgehogs will lie in her panels, and beasts will call in her excavations, ravens in her gateways, because her structure is cedar.

15 This is the contemptuous city dwelling in hope, saying in her heart: I am, and there is no other after me. How she became a disappearance, a pasture for beasts; everyone passing through her will hiss and move his hands.

Chapter 3

1 O manifest and redeemed one, the dove city;

2 she did not hear a voice, did not receive discipline, did not trust in the Lord, and did not draw near to her God.

3 Her rulers within her are like roaring lions; her judges like wolves of Arabia; they left nothing for morning;

4 her prophets are spirit-bearers, contemptuous men; her priests profane the holy things and act impiously toward law.

5 But the Lord is righteous in her midst and will certainly not do injustice; morning by morning he will give his judgment into light, and it was not hidden, and he did not know injustice in exaction, nor injustice for strife.

6 In destruction I pulled down arrogant ones; their corners disappeared; I will lay their roads entirely waste so that no one passes through; their cities failed because no one existed or dwelt there.

7 I said: Only fear me and receive discipline, and you will certainly not be destroyed from her eyes, all that I punished upon her; prepare, rise early; all their gleaning has been destroyed.

8 Therefore await me, says the Lord, for the day of my rising for a testimony; for my judgment is for gatherings of nations, to receive kings, to pour upon them all the wrath of my anger; for all the earth will be consumed in the fire of my jealousy.

9 For then I will turn a tongue upon peoples into its generation, so that all may call upon the name of the Lord, to serve him under one yoke.

10 From the ends of the rivers of Ethiopia they will bring me sacrifices.

11 On that day you will certainly not be put to shame for all your practices with which you acted impiously against me; for then I will remove from you the contemptuous acts of your arrogance, and you will certainly no longer boast over my holy mountain.

12 And I will leave in you a meek and lowly people, and they will revere before the name of the Lord,

13 the remaining ones of Israel, and they will not do injustice or speak vain things, and a deceitful tongue will certainly not be found in their mouth, because they will graze and lie down, and there will be no one frightening them.

14 Rejoice exceedingly, daughter of Sion; proclaim, daughter of Ierusalem; be glad and delight with your whole heart, daughter of Ierusalem.

15 The Lord removed your wrongdoings; he has redeemed you from the hand of your enemies; the king of Israel, the Lord, is in your midst; you will no longer see evil things.

16 At that time the Lord will say to Ierusalem: Take courage, Sion, let your hands not be slack;

17 the Lord your God is in you, a mighty one will save you; he will bring gladness upon you and renew you in his love, and be glad over you with delight as on a day of a feast.

18 And I will gather those who have been crushed; woe, who took up reproach against her?

19 Behold, I act in you for your sake at that time, says the Lord, and I will save her who has been squeezed out and her who has been rejected; I will receive them and make them a boast and renowned in all the earth.

20 And they will be put to shame at that time, when I do well for you, and at the time when I receive you; for I will make you renowned and a boast among all the peoples of the earth, when I turn back your captivity before you, says the Lord.

Haggai

Chapter 1

1 In the second year under Dareios the king, in the sixth month, on the first of the month, a word of the Lord came by the hand of Aggaios the prophet, saying: Say now to Zorobabel son of Salathiel, of the tribe of Iouda, and to Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest, saying:

2 Thus says the Lord Almighty, saying: This people say: The time has not come to build the house of the Lord.

3 And a word of the Lord came by the hand of Aggaios the prophet, saying:

4 Is it a time for you to dwell in your paneled houses, but this house has been laid waste?

5 And now thus says the Lord Almighty: Set now your hearts upon your ways;

6 you sowed much and brought in little, ate and not to fullness, drank and not to drunkenness, clothed yourselves and were not warmed in them, and the one gathering wages gathered into a pierced bundle.

7 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Place your hearts upon your ways;

8 go up upon the mountain and cut wood and build the house, and I will take pleasure in it and be glorified, said the Lord.

9 You looked for much, and it became little; and it was brought into the house, and I blew it away. Therefore thus says the Lord Almighty: Because my house is desolate, but you hurry, each to his house,

10 therefore heaven will refrain from dew, and the earth will withhold its produce;

11 and I will bring a sword upon the earth and upon the mountains and upon the grain and upon the wine and upon the oil and whatever the earth brings forth, and upon men and upon beasts and upon all the labors of their hands. –

12 And Zorobabel son of Salathiel, of the tribe of Iouda, and Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest, and all the remaining ones of the people heard the voice of the Lord their God and the words of Aggaios the prophet, as the Lord their God sent him to them, and the people feared before the Lord.

13 And Aggaios the messenger of the Lord said to the people: I am with you, says the Lord.

14 And the Lord roused the spirit of Zorobabel son of Salathiel, of the tribe of Iouda, and the spirit of Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest, and the spirit of the remaining ones of all the people, and they entered and were doing works in the house of the Lord Almighty their God,

15 on the twenty-fourth of the sixth month in the second year under Dareios the king.

Chapter 2

1 In the seventh month, on the twenty-first of the month, the Lord spoke by the hand of Aggaios the prophet, saying:

2 Say now to Zorobabel son of Salathiel, of the tribe of Iouda, and to Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest, and to all the remaining ones of the people, saying:

3 Who among you saw this house in its former glory? And how do you see it now? As though not existing before you.

4 And now be strong, Zorobabel, says the Lord, and be strong, Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest, and let all the people of the land be strong, says the Lord, and work; for I am with you, says the Lord Almighty,

5 and my spirit stands in your midst; take courage.

6 For thus says the Lord Almighty: Yet once I will shake heaven and earth and sea and dry land;

7 and I will shake all the nations together, and the choice things of all the nations will come, and I will fill this house with glory, says the Lord Almighty.

8 Mine is the silver and mine the gold, says the Lord Almighty.

9 For the latter glory of this house will be great beyond the first, says the Lord Almighty; and in this place I will give peace, says the Lord Almighty, and peace of soul as a possession for everyone building to raise this temple.

10 On the twenty-fourth of the ninth month of the second year under Dareios, a word of the Lord came to Aggaios the prophet, saying:

11 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Ask the priests about law, saying:

12 If a man takes holy meat in the edge of his garment, and the edge of his garment touches bread or boiled food or wine or oil or any food, will it be sanctified? And the priests answered and said: No.

13 And Aggaios said: If one defiled by a soul touches any of these things, will it be defiled? And the priests answered and said: It will be defiled.

14 And Aggaios answered and said: So is this people, and so is this nation before me, says the Lord, and so are all the works of their hands, and whoever approaches there will be defiled because of their morning gains; they will suffer pain before their troubles; and you hated those reproving in the gates.

15 And now place in your hearts, from this day and above, before placing stone upon stone in the temple of the Lord,

16 what you were; when you were putting twenty sata of barley into a bin, it became ten sata of barley; and you were entering the vat to draw fifty measures, and they became twenty.

17 I struck you with barrenness and destruction by wind and hail, all the works of your hands, and you did not return to me, says the Lord.

18 Subject now your hearts from this day and beyond; from the twenty-fourth of the ninth month and from the day when the temple of the Lord was founded, place in your hearts

19 whether it will still be recognized upon the threshing floor, and whether still the vine and the fig tree and the pomegranate and the olive trees which bear no fruit; from this day I will bless.

20 And a word of the Lord came a second time to Aggaios the prophet, on the twenty-fourth of the month, saying:

21 Say to Zorobabel son of Salathiel, of the tribe of Iouda, saying: I shake heaven and earth and sea and dry land,

22 and I will overturn thrones of kings and destroy the force of kings of the nations and overturn chariots and riders, and horses and their riders will come down, each with a sword against his brother.

23 On that day, says the Lord Almighty, I will take you, Zorobabel son of Salathiel, my slave, says the Lord, and make you like a seal, because I chose you, says the Lord Almighty.

Zechariah

Chapter 1

1 In the eighth month of the second year under Dareios, a word of the Lord came to Zacharias son of Barachias, son of Addo, the prophet, saying:

2 The Lord was angry with your fathers with great wrath.

3 And you will say to them: Thus says the Lord Almighty: Return to me, and I will return to you, says the Lord.

4 And do not become like your fathers, whom the former prophets accused, saying: Thus says the Lord Almighty: Turn from your evil ways and from your evil practices, and they paid no attention to hearing me, says the Lord.

5 Where are your fathers? And will the prophets live for the age?

6 Only receive my words and my ordinances, whatever I command in my spirit to my slaves the prophets, who overtook your fathers. And they answered and said: As the Lord Almighty has drawn himself up to act according to your ways and according to your practices, so he acted for you.

7 On the twenty-fourth in the eleventh month – this is the month Sabat – in the second year under Dareios, a word of the Lord came to Zacharias son of Barachias, son of Addo, the prophet, saying:

8 I have seen the night, and behold, a man mounted upon a red horse, and he stood between the two shaded mountains, and behind him red and gray and variegated and white horses.

9 And I said: What are these, lord? And the angel speaking in me said to me: I will show you what these things are.

10 And the man standing between the mountains answered and said to me: These are those whom the Lord has sent out to go around the earth.

11 And they answered the angel of the Lord standing between the mountains and said: We have gone around all the earth, and behold, all the earth is inhabited and quiet.

12 And the angel of the Lord answered and said: Lord Almighty, how long will you not have mercy on Ierusalem and the cities of Iouda, which you disregarded this seventieth year?

13 And the Lord Almighty answered the angel speaking in me with good sayings and consoling words.

14 And the angel speaking in me said to me: Cry out, saying: Thus says the Lord Almighty: I have been jealous for Ierusalem and Sion with great jealousy,

15 and I am angry with great wrath against the nations joining in attack, because I was angry a little, but they joined in attack for evil things.

16 Therefore thus says the Lord: I will return to Ierusalem with compassion, and my house will be rebuilt in her, says the Lord Almighty, and a measure will yet be stretched over Ierusalem.

17 And the angel speaking in me said to me: Cry out, saying: Thus says the Lord Almighty: Cities will yet overflow with good things, and the Lord will yet have mercy on Sion and yet choose Ierusalem.

Chapter 2

1 And I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, four horns.

2 And I said to the angel speaking in me: What are these, lord? And he said to me: These are the horns that scattered Iouda and Israel.

3 And the Lord showed me four craftsmen.

4 And I said: What are these coming to do? And he said to me: These horns that scattered Iouda and Israel broke them, and none of them lifted a head; and these entered to sharpen them into their hands, the four horns, the nations raising a horn against the land of the Lord to scatter it.

5 And I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, a man, and in his hand a land-measuring cord.

6 And I said to him: Where are you going? And he said to me: To measure Ierusalem, to see how great its breadth is and how great its length.

7 And behold, the angel speaking in me stood, and another angel was going out to meet him,

8 and said to him, saying: Run and speak to that young man, saying: Ierusalem will be inhabited fruitfully because of a multitude of men and beasts in her midst;

9 and I will be for her, says the Lord, a wall of fire round about, and I will be for glory in her midst.

10 O, O, flee from the land of the north, says the Lord, because from the four winds of heaven I will gather you, says the Lord;

11 save yourselves into Sion, those dwelling in the daughter of Babylon.

12 For thus says the Lord Almighty: After glory he has sent me against the nations which despoiled you, because the one touching you is like one touching the pupil of his eye;

13 for behold, I bring my hand upon them, and they will be spoils for those enslaved to them, and you will know that the Lord Almighty has sent me.

14 Delight and be glad, daughter of Sion, for behold, I come and will dwell in your midst, says the Lord.

15 And many nations will take refuge in the Lord on that day and be a people for him and dwell in your midst, and you will know that the Lord Almighty has sent me to you.

16 And the Lord will inherit Iouda, his portion, upon the holy land, and yet choose Ierusalem.

17 Let all flesh revere before the Lord, because he has been roused from his holy clouds.

Chapter 3

1 And he showed me Iesous the great priest standing before the angel of the Lord, and the devil stood at his right to oppose him.

2 And the Lord said to the devil: May the Lord rebuke you, devil, and may the Lord who chose Ierusalem rebuke you; is this not, behold, like a firebrand pulled out of fire?

3 And Iesous was clothed in filthy garments and stood before the angel.

4 And he answered and said to those standing before him, saying: Remove the filthy garments from him. And he said to him: Behold, I have removed your lawless deeds, and clothe him in a robe reaching the feet,

5 and place a clean turban upon his head. And they clothed him in garments and placed a clean turban upon his head, and the angel of the Lord stood.

6 And the angel of the Lord solemnly testified to Iesous, saying:

7 Thus says the Lord Almighty: If you walk in my ways and if you keep my ordinances, you too will judge my house; and if you indeed guard my court, I will also give you those going about among these who stand.

8 Hear now, Iesous the great priest, you and your neighbors sitting before you, because they are men observing portents; for behold, I bring my slave, Rising;

9 for the stone which I gave before Iesous, upon the one stone there are seven eyes; behold, I dig a pit, says the Lord Almighty, and I will feel for all the injustice of that land in one day.

10 On that day, says the Lord Almighty, you will invite, each his neighbor, beneath a vine and beneath a fig tree.

Chapter 4

1 And the angel speaking in me returned and roused me as when a man is roused from his sleep,

2 and said to me: What do you see? And I said: I have seen, and behold, a lampstand wholly gold, and its lamp bowl above it, and seven lamps above it, and seven pouring vessels for the lamps above it;

3 and two olive trees above it, one to the right of the lamp bowl and one to the left.

4 And I asked and said to the angel speaking in me, saying: What are these, lord?

5 And the angel speaking in me answered and said to me: Do you not know what these are? And I said: No, lord.

6 And he answered and said to me, saying: This is the word of the Lord to Zorobabel, saying: Not by a great force nor by strength, but by my spirit, says the Lord Almighty.

7 Who are you, great mountain, before Zorobabel, to set things right? And I will bring out the stone of inheritance, equality of grace, its grace.

8 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying:

9 The hands of Zorobabel founded this house, and his hands will complete it, and you will know that the Lord Almighty has sent me to you.

10 For who despised small days? And they will rejoice and see the tin stone in the hand of Zorobabel. These seven are the eyes of the Lord looking upon all the earth.

11 And I answered and said to him: What are these two olive trees to the right of the lampstand and to the left?

12 And I asked a second time and said to him: What are the two branches of the olive trees in the hands of the two golden spouts pouring upon and bringing up the golden pouring vessels?

13 And he said to me: Do you not know what these are? And I said: No, lord.

14 And he said: These two sons of fatness stand beside the Lord of all the earth.

Chapter 5

1 And I turned and lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, a flying sickle.

2 And he said to me: What do you see? And I said: I see a flying sickle, twenty cubits long and ten cubits wide.

3 And he said to me: This is the curse going out over the face of all the earth, because every thief will be punished from this unto death, and every perjurer will be punished from this unto death;

4 and I will bring it out, says the Lord Almighty, and it will enter the house of the thief and the house of the one swearing falsely by my name, and lodge in the midst of his house and bring it and its wood and its stones to an end.

5 And the angel speaking in me went out and said to me: Look up with your eyes and see what this thing going out is.

6 And I said: What is it? And he said: This is the measure going out. And he said: This is their injustice in all the earth.

7 And behold, a talent of lead being lifted, and behold, one woman sat in the midst of the measure.

8 And he said: This is lawlessness; and he cast her into the midst of the measure and cast the stone of lead into her mouth.

9 And I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, two women going out, and wind in their wings, and they had wings like a hoopoe's wings; and they lifted the measure between earth and heaven.

10 And I said to the angel speaking in me: Where are these carrying away the measure?

11 And he said to me: To build a house for it in the land of Babylon and prepare it, and they will place it there upon its prepared place.

Chapter 6

1 And I turned and lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, four chariots going out from between two mountains, and the mountains were bronze mountains.

2 In the first chariot red horses, and in the second chariot black horses,

3 and in the third chariot white horses, and in the fourth chariot variegated gray horses.

4 And I answered and said to the angel speaking in me: What are these, lord?

5 And the angel speaking in me answered and said: These are the four winds of heaven; they go out to stand beside the Lord of all the earth;

6 that in which the black horses were, they were going out to the land of the north, and the white ones were going out behind them, and the variegated ones were going out to the land of the south,

7 and the gray ones were going out and looking to go, to go around the earth. And he said: Go and go around the earth; and they went around the earth.

8 And he cried out and spoke to me, saying: Behold, those going out to the land of the north brought my anger to rest in the land of the north.

9 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying:

10 Take the things from the captivity from its rulers and from its useful ones and from those who have known it, and you will enter on that day into the house of Iosias son of Sophonias, who has come from Babylon,

11 and take silver and gold and make crowns and place them upon the head of Iesous son of Iosedek, the great priest,

12 and say to him: Thus says the Lord Almighty: Behold, a man, Rising is his name, and beneath him he will rise, and he will build the house of the Lord;

13 and he will receive excellence and sit and rule upon his throne, and the priest will be at his right, and peaceful counsel will be between both.

14 But the crown will be for those awaiting and for its useful ones and for those who have known it, and for the favor of the son of Sophonias and for a song in the house of the Lord.

15 And those far from them will come and build in the house of the Lord, and you will know that the Lord Almighty has sent me to you; and it will be, if hearing, you hear the voice of the Lord your God.

Chapter 7

1 And it happened in the fourth year under Dareios the king that a word of the Lord came to Zacharias on the fourth of the ninth month, which is Chaseleu,

2 and the king sent Sarasar and Arbeseer and his men to Baithel to propitiate the Lord,

3 saying to the priests in the house of the Lord Almighty and to the prophets, saying: The sanctification has entered here in the fifth month, as I have already done for considerable years.

4 And a word of the Lord of forces came to me, saying:

5 Say to all the people of the land and to the priests, saying: If you fast or beat your breasts on the fifths or on the sevenths, and behold, seventy years, did you fast a fast for me?

6 And if you eat or drink, is it not you who eat and you who drink?

7 Are these not the words which the Lord spoke by the hands of the former prophets, when Ierusalem was inhabited and prospering, and her cities round about, and the hill country and the plain were inhabited?

8 And a word of the Lord came to Zacharias, saying:

9 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Judge righteous judgment and do mercy and compassion, each toward his brother,

10 and do not oppress widow and orphan and proselyte and needy one, and let no one bear a grudge for his brother's evil in your hearts.

11 And they refused to pay attention and gave a deranged back and made their ears heavy so as not to hear,

12 and appointed their heart disobedient so as not to hear my law and the words which the Lord Almighty sent out in his spirit by the hands of the former prophets; and great wrath came from the Lord Almighty.

13 And it will be, as he spoke and they did not hear him, so they will cry, and I will certainly not hear, says the Lord Almighty.

14 And I will cast them out into all the nations which they did not know, and the land will disappear behind them, without anyone passing through or returning; and they consigned a choice land to disappearance.

Chapter 8

1 And a word of the Lord Almighty came, saying:

2 Thus says the Lord Almighty: I was jealous for Ierusalem and Sion with great jealousy, and with great anger I was jealous for her.

3 Thus says the Lord: And I will return to Sion and dwell in the midst of Ierusalem, and Ierusalem will be called the true city, and the mountain of the Lord Almighty a holy mountain.

4 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Old men and old women will yet sit in the squares of Ierusalem, each having his staff in his hand because of a multitude of days;

5 and the squares of the city will be filled with boys and girls playing in her squares.

6 Thus says the Lord Almighty: For if it is impossible before the remaining ones of this people in those days, will it also be impossible before me? says the Lord Almighty.

7 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Behold, I save my people from the land of the east and from the land of the west,

8 and I will bring them in and dwell in the midst of Ierusalem, and they will be a people for me, and I will be a God for them in truth and righteousness.

9 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Let your hands be strong, those hearing in these days these words from the mouth of the prophets, from the day when the house of the Lord Almighty has been founded, and the temple from when it has been built.

10 For before those days the wage of men will not be for benefit, and the wage of beasts will not exist, and for the one going out and the one entering there will be no peace because of affliction; and I will send out all men, each against his neighbor.

11 And now I do not act for the remaining ones of this people as in the former days, says the Lord Almighty,

12 but I will show peace; the vine will give its fruit, and the earth its produce, and heaven its dew, and I will give all these things as an inheritance to the remaining ones of my people.

13 And as you were under a curse among the nations, house of Iouda and house of Israel, so I will save you, and you will be under a blessing; take courage and be strong in your hands.

14 For thus says the Lord Almighty: As I intended to harm you when your fathers provoked me to anger, says the Lord Almighty, and did not change my mind,

15 so I have drawn myself up and intended in these days to do well for Ierusalem and the house of Iouda; take courage.

16 These are the words which you will do: Speak truth, each to his neighbor, and judge peaceful judgment in your gates,

17 and do not devise, each, the evil of his neighbor in your hearts, and do not love a false oath, because I hated all these things, says the Lord Almighty.

18 And a word of the Lord Almighty came to me, saying:

19 Thus says the Lord Almighty: The fourth fast and the fifth fast and the seventh fast and the tenth fast will be joy and gladness and good feasts for the house of Iouda, and you will be glad; and love truth and peace.

20 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Many peoples will yet come, and those dwelling in many cities;

21 and those dwelling in five cities will come together into one city, saying: Let us go to beseech the face of the Lord and seek out the face of the Lord Almighty; I too will go.

22 And many peoples and many nations will come to seek out the face of the Lord Almighty in Ierusalem and to propitiate the face of the Lord.

23 Thus says the Lord Almighty: In those days, if ten men from all the tongues of the nations take hold and take hold of the fringe of a Ioudaian man's garment, saying: We will go with you, because we have heard that God is with you.

Chapter 9

1 An oracle of a word of the Lord; in the land of Sedrach and Damascus is his sacrifice, because the Lord watches men and all the tribes of Israel.

2 And Emath in her boundaries, Tyre and Sidon, because they were exceedingly wise.

3 And Tyre built strongholds for herself and treasured silver like dust and gathered gold like mud of roads.

4 Therefore the Lord will inherit her and strike her force into the sea, and she will be consumed with fire.

5 Askalon will see and fear, and Gaza too, and suffer exceedingly, and Akkaron, because she was put to shame at her fall; and a king will perish from Gaza, and Askalon will certainly not be inhabited.

6 And foreigners will dwell in Azotos, and I will bring down the arrogance of foreigners.

7 And I will remove their blood from their mouth and their abominations from between their teeth, and this one too will remain for our God, and they will be like a commander of a thousand in Iouda, and Akkaron like the Iebousite.

8 And I will establish a defense for my house, so that none passes through or returns, and one driving out will certainly no longer come upon them, because now I have seen with my eyes.

9 Rejoice exceedingly, daughter of Sion; proclaim, daughter of Ierusalem; behold, your king comes to you, righteous and saving, meek and mounted upon a beast of burden and a young colt.

10 And he will destroy chariots from Ephraim and a horse from Ierusalem, and a war bow will be destroyed, and a multitude and peace from nations; and he will rule waters as far as the sea, and rivers, the outlets of the earth.

11 And you, by blood of a covenant, sent out your prisoners from a pit having no water.

12 You will sit in a stronghold, prisoners of the gathering, and for one day of your sojourning I will repay you double;

13 for I stretched you, Iouda, as a bow for myself, filled Ephraim, and will rouse your children, Sion, against the children of the Greeks and handle you like a fighter's sword;

14 and the Lord will be over them, and a missile will go out like lightning, and the Lord Almighty will sound a trumpet and go in the tossing of his threat.

15 The Lord Almighty will shield them, and they will consume them and bury them with sling stones and drink them down like wine and fill an altar like bowls.

16 And the Lord will save them on that day, his people like sheep, because holy stones roll upon his land.

17 For if anything is good of his and if anything beautiful from him, grain for young men and fragrant wine for virgins.

Chapter 10

1 Ask rain from the Lord in season, early and late; the Lord made apparitions, and will give them winter rain, to each vegetation in a field.

2 For the utterers spoke troubles, and the diviners false visions, and they were speaking false dreams, vainly consoling; therefore they were removed like sheep and harmed, because there was no healing.

3 My anger was provoked against the shepherds, and I will visit the lambs; and the Lord God the Almighty will visit his flock, the house of Iouda, and appoint them like his splendid horse in war.

4 And from him he looked, and from him he appointed, and from him a bow in anger; from him everyone driving out will go out together.

5 And they will be like fighters treading mud in the roads in war, and draw themselves up, because the Lord is with them, and riders of horses will be put to shame.

6 And I will strengthen the house of Iouda and save the house of Ioseph and settle them, because I loved them, and they will be as though I had not turned them away, because I am the Lord their God and will hear them.

7 And they will be like fighters of Ephraim, and their heart will rejoice as with wine; and their children will see and be glad, and their heart will rejoice in the Lord.

8 I will signal to them and receive them, because I will redeem them, and they will be multiplied as they were numerous;

9 and I will sow them among peoples, and those far away will remember me, nourish their children and return.

10 And I will return them from the land of Egypt and receive them from Assyrians and bring them into Galaaditis and into Lebanon, and not even one of them will certainly be left behind;

11 and they will pass through a narrow sea and strike waves in the sea, and all the depths of rivers will dry up, and all the arrogance of Assyrians will be removed, and a scepter of Egypt taken away.

12 And I will strengthen them in the Lord their God, and they will boast in his name, says the Lord.

Chapter 11

1 Open your doors, Lebanon, and let fire devour your cedars;

2 let a pine howl, because a cedar has fallen, because grandees suffered great misery; howl, oaks of Basanitis, because the closely grown thicket was pulled down.

3 A sound of lamenting shepherds, because their greatness has suffered misery; a sound of roaring lions, because the pride of the Iordan has suffered misery.

4 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Shepherd the sheep of slaughter,

5 which their possessors were slaughtering and did not regret, and those selling them were saying: Blessed is the Lord, and we have become rich, and their shepherds suffered nothing over them.

6 Therefore I will no longer spare those dwelling in the earth, says the Lord, and behold, I hand over men, each into the hands of his neighbor and into the hands of his king, and they will cut down the earth, and I will certainly not rescue from their hand.

7 And I will shepherd the sheep of slaughter into Chanaanitis; and I will take two staffs for myself – the one I called Beauty and the other I called Measured Portion – and I will shepherd the sheep.

8 And I will remove the three shepherds in one month, and my soul will be weighed down over them, for their souls too were roaring against me.

9 And I said: I will not shepherd you; let the dying one die, and let the failing one fail, and let the remaining ones devour, each, the flesh of his neighbor.

10 And I will take my beautiful staff and cast it away, to disperse my covenant which I made with all the peoples;

11 and it will be dispersed on that day, and the Chananites will know the sheep that are guarded, because it is a word of the Lord.

12 And I will say to them: If it is good before you, give my wage, weighing it, or refuse; and they weighed my wage, thirty silver pieces.

13 And the Lord said to me: Put them down into the smelting furnace, and consider whether it is approved, as I was tested on their behalf. And I took the thirty silver pieces and cast them into the house of the Lord, into the smelting furnace.

14 And I cast away the second staff, Measured Portion, to disperse the possession between Iouda and Israel.

15 And the Lord said to me: Yet take for yourself the shepherd's equipment of an inexperienced shepherd.

16 For behold, I rouse a shepherd upon the land; he will certainly not visit the failing one or seek the scattered one or heal the crushed one or guide the whole one, and he will devour the flesh of the choice ones and wrench their ankle bones out.

17 O those shepherding vain things and those who have abandoned the sheep; a sword upon his arms and upon his right eye; drying, his arm will dry up, and blinding, his right eye will be blinded.

Chapter 12

1 An oracle of a word of the Lord against Israel; says the Lord, who stretches heaven and founds earth and forms the spirit of man within him:

2 Behold, I make Ierusalem like shaking doorways for all the peoples round about, and in Ioudaia there will be a siege against Ierusalem.

3 And on that day I will make Ierusalem a stone trampled by all the nations; everyone trampling her, mocking, will be mocked, and all the nations of the earth will gather against her.

4 On that day, says the Lord Almighty, I will strike every horse with astonishment and its rider with derangement, but over the house of Iouda I will open my eyes, and strike all the horses of the peoples with blindness.

5 And the commanders of thousands of Iouda will say in their hearts: We will find for ourselves those dwelling in Ierusalem in the Lord Almighty their God.

6 On that day I will make the commanders of thousands of Iouda like a firebrand among wood and like a torch of fire among straw, and they will devour to the right and to the left all the peoples round about, and Ierusalem will yet dwell by herself.

7 And the Lord will save the dwellings of Iouda as from the beginning, so that the boast of the house of David and the exaltation of those dwelling in Ierusalem may not be magnified over Iouda.

8 And on that day the Lord will shield those dwelling in Ierusalem, and the weak one among them on that day will be like the house of David, but the house of David like the house of God, like an angel of the Lord before them.

9 And on that day I will seek to remove all the nations coming against Ierusalem.

10 And I will pour upon the house of David and upon those dwelling in Ierusalem a spirit of grace and compassion, and they will look toward me because they danced in triumph against me, and beat their breasts over him as over a beloved one, and suffer anguish as over a firstborn.

11 On that day the beating of the breast will be magnified in Ierusalem like mourning for a pomegranate grove cut down in a plain,

12 and the land will beat its breast tribe by tribe, a tribe by itself and their women by themselves, the tribe of the house of David by itself and their women by themselves, the tribe of the house of Nathan by itself and their women by themselves,

13 the tribe of the house of Leui by itself and their women by themselves, the tribe of Symeon by itself and their women by themselves,

14 all the remaining tribes, a tribe by itself and their women by themselves.

Chapter 13

1 On that day every place will be opened in the house of David.

2 And on that day, says the Lord, I will destroy the names of the idols from the land, and there will no longer be remembrance of them; and I will remove the false prophets and the unclean spirit from the land.

3 And if a man yet prophesies, his father and his mother who begot him will say to him: You will not live, because you spoke false things in the name of the Lord; and his father and his mother who begot him will bind his feet together when he prophesies.

4 And on that day the prophets will be put to shame, each for his vision when he prophesies, and they will put on a hairy skin because they lied.

5 And he will say: I am not a prophet, for I am a man working the earth, because a man begot me from my youth.

6 And I will say to him: What are these wounds between your hands? And he will say: Those with which I was wounded in my beloved house.

7 Sword, be roused against my shepherds and against a man, my fellow citizen, says the Lord Almighty; strike the shepherds and pull out the sheep, and I will bring my hand upon the shepherds.

8 And in all the land, says the Lord, the two parts will be destroyed and fail, but the third will remain in it;

9 and I will bring the third through fire and refine them as silver is refined and test them as gold is tested; he will call upon my name, and I will hear him and say: This is my people, and he will say: The Lord is my God.

Chapter 14

1 Behold, days of the Lord are coming, and your spoils will be divided within you.

2 And I will gather all the nations against Ierusalem for war, and the city will be taken, and the houses plundered, and the women defiled, and half the city will go out into captivity, but the remaining ones of my people will certainly not be destroyed from the city.

3 And the Lord will go out and draw himself up among those nations, as on the day of his battle array on a day of war.

4 And his feet will stand on that day upon the mountain of olives opposite Ierusalem to the east; and the mountain of olives will be split, half of it toward the east and half toward the sea, an exceedingly great chasm; and half the mountain will incline toward the north and half toward the south.

5 And the ravine of my mountains will be blocked, and a ravine of mountains will be joined as far as Iasol and be blocked as it was blocked in the days of the earthquake in the days of Ozias king of Iouda; and the Lord my God will come, and all the holy ones with him.

6 On that day there will be no light and cold and frost;

7 it will be one day, and that day known to the Lord, and neither day nor night, and toward evening there will be light.

8 And on that day living water will go out from Ierusalem, half of it into the first sea and half of it into the last sea, and in summer and in spring it will be thus.

9 And the Lord will be king over all the earth; on that day the Lord will be one and his name one.

10 Encircling all the land and the wilderness from Gabe as far as Remmon south of Ierusalem; but Rama will remain in place from the gate of Beniamin as far as the place of the first gate, as far as the gate of the corners and as far as the tower of Ananeel, as far as the king's vats.

11 They will dwell in her, and there will no longer be a thing devoted to destruction, and Ierusalem will dwell confidently.

12 And this will be the fall with which the Lord will strike all the peoples that marched against Ierusalem; their flesh will melt while they stand upon their feet, and their eyes will flow from their sockets, and their tongue will melt in their mouth.

13 And on that day a great astonishment from the Lord will be upon them, and each will take hold of his neighbor's hand, and his hand will be entangled with the hand of his neighbor.

14 And Ioudas will draw himself up in Ierusalem and gather the strength of all the peoples round about, gold and silver and clothing in an exceedingly great multitude.

15 And this will be the fall of the horses and the mules and the camels and the donkeys and all the beasts in those camps, according to this fall.

16 And as many as are left of all the nations which came against Ierusalem will go up yearly to bow down to the king, the Lord Almighty, and celebrate the feast of tent pitching.

17 And as many as do not go up from all the tribes of the earth to Ierusalem to bow down to the king, the Lord Almighty, these too will be added to those.

18 But if the tribe of Egypt does not go up or come there, upon these too will be the fall with which the Lord will strike all the nations that do not go up to celebrate the feast of tent pitching.

19 This will be the sin of Egypt and the sin of all the nations that do not go up to celebrate the feast of tent pitching.

20 On that day what is upon the bridle of the horse will be holy to the Lord Almighty, and the cauldrons in the house of the Lord will be like bowls before the altar,

21 and every cauldron in Ierusalem and in Iouda will be holy to the Lord Almighty; and all those sacrificing will come and take of them and boil in them. And there will no longer be a Chananite in the house of the Lord Almighty on that day.

Malachi

Chapter 1

1 An oracle of a word of the Lord against Israel by the hand of his messenger; place it now upon your hearts.

2 I loved you, says the Lord. And you said: In what did you love us? Was Esau not Iakob's brother? says the Lord; and I loved Iakob,

3 but hated Esau and consigned his boundaries to disappearance and his inheritance to gifts of a wilderness.

4 For Idoumaia will say: It has been overturned, and let us return and rebuild the desolate places; thus says the Lord Almighty: They will build, and I will overturn; and they will be called boundaries of lawlessness and a people against whom the Lord has drawn himself up until an age.

5 And your eyes will see, and you will say: The Lord was magnified beyond the boundaries of Israel.

6 A son glorifies a father and a slave his lord. And if I am a father, where is my glory? And if I am a lord, where is my fear? says the Lord Almighty. You priests who disparage my name; and you said: In what did we disparage your name?

7 Bringing polluted loaves to my altar. And you said: In what did we pollute them? In your saying: The table of the Lord is despised, and the food placed upon it despised.

8 For if you bring a blind one for sacrifice, is it not evil? And if you bring a lame or sick one, is it not evil? Bring it now to your governor, whether he will accept it, whether he will receive your face, says the Lord Almighty.

9 And now propitiate the face of your God and beseech him; these things have happened by your hands; shall I receive your faces from you? says the Lord Almighty.

10 For doors will also be shut among you, and you will not kindle my altar for nothing; I have no pleasure in you, says the Lord Almighty, and I will not accept a sacrifice from your hands.

11 For from the rising of the sun to its setting my name has been glorified among the nations, and in every place incense is brought to my name and a pure sacrifice, because my name is great among the nations, says the Lord Almighty.

12 But you profane it by saying: The table of the Lord is polluted, and its food placed upon it has been despised.

13 And you said: These things are from hardship, and I blew them away, says the Lord Almighty; and you were bringing plunder and lame things and afflicted things; and if you bring the sacrifice, shall I accept them from your hands? says the Lord Almighty.

14 And cursed is one who was able, and a male existed in his flock, and his vow was upon it, and he sacrifices a spoiled one to the Lord; for I am a great king, says the Lord Almighty, and my name is manifest among the nations.

Chapter 2

1 And now this command is for you, priests;

2 if you do not hear, and if you do not place in your heart to give glory to my name, says the Lord Almighty, I will also send the curse upon you and curse your blessing and curse it; and I will disperse your blessing, and it will not be among you, because you do not place it in your heart.

3 Behold, I set apart the shoulder for you and will scatter the stomach upon your faces, the stomach of your feasts, and I will take you to the same place;

4 and you will know that I have sent this command to you, so that my covenant may be with the Leuites, says the Lord Almighty.

5 My covenant was with him, of life and peace, and I gave it to him in fear, to fear me and shrink before my name.

6 A law of truth was in his mouth, and injustice was not found on his lips; directing rightly in peace, he walked with me and turned many from injustice.

7 For a priest's lips will guard knowledge, and they will seek out law from his mouth, because he is a messenger of the Lord Almighty.

8 But you turned aside from the way and made many weak in law; you destroyed the covenant of Leui, says the Lord Almighty.

9 And I have made you despised and slack among all the nations, because you did not guard my ways, but were receiving faces in law.

10 Did not one God create you? Is there not one father of all of you? Why did you abandon, each, his brother, to profane the covenant of your fathers?

11 Ioudas was abandoned, and an abomination arose in Israel and in Ierusalem, because Ioudas profaned the holy things of the Lord which he loved, and practiced toward foreign gods.

12 The Lord will destroy the man doing these things, until he is also humbled from the dwellings of Iakob and from those bringing a sacrifice to the Lord Almighty.

13 And these things which I hated you were doing; you were covering the altar of the Lord with tears and weeping and groaning from troubles. Is it still fitting to look upon a sacrifice or take an acceptable thing from your hands?

14 And you said: For what reason? Because the Lord solemnly testified between you and the wife of your youth, whom you abandoned, and she is your companion and the wife of your covenant.

15 And no other did it, and a remnant of his spirit. And you said: What else but seed does God seek? And guard yourselves in your spirit, and do not abandon the wife of your youth;

16 but if, hating, you send her away, says the Lord God of Israel, impiety will also cover your thoughts, says the Lord Almighty. And guard yourselves in your spirit, and you will certainly not abandon.

17 Those provoking God with your words, and you said: In what did we provoke him? In your saying: Everyone doing evil is good before the Lord, and he took pleasure in them; and: Where is the God of righteousness?

Chapter 3

1 Behold, I send out my messenger, and he will look upon a way before me, and suddenly the Lord whom you seek will come to his own temple, and the messenger of the covenant whom you desire; behold, he comes, says the Lord Almighty.

2 And who will endure the day of his entry? Or who will stand at his appearance? For he enters like fire of a smelting furnace and like the herb of washers.

3 And he will sit smelting and purifying like silver and like gold; and he will purify the sons of Leui and melt them like gold and like silver; and they will be bringing a sacrifice to the Lord in righteousness.

4 And a sacrifice of Iouda and Ierusalem will please the Lord as in the days of the age and as in the former years.

5 And I will draw near to you in judgment and be a swift witness against the sorceresses and the adulteresses and those swearing falsely by my name, and those withholding a hired worker's wage and those oppressing a widow and those striking orphans with their fists and those turning aside the judgment of a proselyte and those not fearing me, says the Lord Almighty.

6 For I am the Lord your God, and I have not changed; and you, sons of Iakob, do not refrain

7 from the injustices of your fathers; you turned aside from my ordinances and did not guard them. Return to me, and I will return to you, says the Lord Almighty. And you said: In what shall we return?

8 Will a man supplant God? For you supplant me. And you will say: In what have we supplanted you? Because the tithes and the firstfruits are with you;

9 and looking away, you look away, and you supplant me; the nation was brought to an end.

10 And you brought all the produce into the storehouses, and in his house will be his plunder. Examine now by this, says the Lord Almighty, whether I will not open for you the floodgates of heaven and pour my blessing upon you until there is sufficiency;

11 and I will set apart for you for food and certainly not destroy your fruit of the earth, and your vine in the field will certainly not grow weak, says the Lord Almighty.

12 And all the nations will call you blessed, because you will be a desired land, says the Lord Almighty.

13 You made your words heavy against me, says the Lord, and you said: In what did we speak against you?

14 You said: Vain is the one serving God, and what more is there, that we guarded his observances and went as suppliants before the Lord Almighty?

15 And now we call strangers blessed, and all those doing lawless things are built up, and they resisted God and were saved.

16 Those fearing the Lord spoke these things, each to his neighbor; and the Lord attended and heard and wrote a book of remembrance before him for those fearing the Lord and revering his name.

17 And they will be mine, says the Lord Almighty, for a day which I make for a possession, and I will choose them as a man chooses his son serving him.

18 And you will return and see between righteous and lawless, and between the one serving God and the one not serving.

19 For behold, the day of the Lord comes burning like an oven and will burn them, and all the foreigners and all those doing lawless things will be straw, and the coming day will kindle them, says the Lord Almighty, and neither root nor branch will certainly remain of them.

20 And for you who fear my name a sun of righteousness will rise, and healing in its wings, and you will go out and leap like calves released from bonds.

21 And you will trample lawless ones, because they will be ashes beneath your feet on the day which I make, says the Lord Almighty.

22 And behold, I send you Elias the Thesbite before the great and manifest day of the Lord comes,

23 who will restore a father's heart to a son and a man's heart to his neighbor, lest I come and strike the earth utterly.

24 Remember the law of Moyses my slave, as I commanded him at Choreb for all Israel, ordinances and statutes.

Isaiah

Chapter 1

1 A vision which Esaias son of Amos saw, which he saw against Ioudaia and against Ierusalem in the reign of Ozias and Ioatham and Achaz and Ezekias, who reigned over Ioudaia.

2 Hear, heaven, and give ear, earth, because the Lord spoke: I begot sons and raised them, but they rejected me.

3 An ox knew its owner and a donkey its lord's manger; but Israel did not know me, and the people did not understand me.

4 Woe, sinful nation, people full of sins, evil seed, lawless sons; you abandoned the Lord and provoked the holy one of Israel to anger.

5 Why should you yet be struck, adding lawlessness? Every head is in pain and every heart in grief.

6 From feet to head, neither wound nor bruise nor inflamed injury; there is no poultice to apply, nor oil nor bandages.

7 Your land is desolate, your cities burned with fire; strangers devour your region before you, and it has been laid waste, overturned by foreign peoples.

8 The daughter of Sion will be left like a tent in a vineyard and like a fruit watchman's hut in a cucumber patch, like a besieged city;

9 and if the Lord Sabaoth had not left us seed, we would have become like Sodoma and been made like Gomorra.

10 Hear a word of the Lord, rulers of Sodoma; attend to a law of God, people of Gomorra.

11 What is the multitude of your sacrifices to me? says the Lord; I am full of whole burnt offerings of rams, and I do not desire fat of lambs and blood of bulls and goats,

12 not even if you come to appear to me. For who sought these things from your hands? To tread my court

13 you will no longer proceed; if you bring fine flour, it is vain; incense is an abomination to me; your new moons and sabbaths and a great day I do not endure; fasting and idleness

14 and your new moons and your feasts my soul hates; you became a surfeit to me; I will no longer release your sins.

15 When you stretch your hands toward me, I will turn my eyes from you, and if you multiply supplication, I will not hear you; for your hands are full of blood.

16 Wash yourselves, become clean, remove wickednesses from your souls before my eyes, cease from your wickednesses,

17 learn to do good, seek out judgment, rescue one being wronged, judge for an orphan and vindicate a widow;

18 and come and let us dispute, says the Lord, and if your sins are like purple, I will whiten them like snow, but if they are like scarlet, I will whiten them like wool.

19 And if you are willing and hear me, you will eat the good things of the earth;

20 but if you are unwilling and do not hear me, a sword will devour you; for the mouth of the Lord spoke these things.

21 How faithful city Sion became a prostitute, full of judgment, in which righteousness slept, but now murderers.

22 Your silver is unapproved; your retailers mix wine with water;

23 your rulers disobey, partners of thieves, loving gifts, pursuing recompense, not judging for orphans and not attending to the judgment of widows.

24 Therefore thus says the Master, the Lord Sabaoth: Woe to the strong ones of Israel; for my anger will not cease against adversaries, and I will exact judgment from my enemies.

25 And I will bring my hand upon you and refine you to purity, but destroy the disobedient and remove all lawless ones from you and humble all arrogant ones.

26 And I will appoint your judges as formerly and your counselors as from the beginning; and after these things you will be called City of righteousness, faithful mother-city Sion.

27 For her captivity will be saved with judgment and with mercy;

28 and the lawless and the sinners will be crushed together, and those abandoning the Lord will be brought to an end.

29 For they will be ashamed of their idols which they desired, and were put to shame over their gardens which they coveted;

30 for they will be like a terebinth that has shed its leaves and like a garden having no water;

31 and their strength will be like straw of tow and their works like sparks of fire, and the lawless and the sinners will be burned together, and there will be no one quenching.

Chapter 2

1 The word which came from the Lord to Esaias son of Amos concerning Ioudaia and concerning Ierusalem.

2 For in the last days the mountain of the Lord will be manifest, and the house of God upon the summits of the mountains, and it will be raised above the hills; and all the nations will come to it,

3 and many nations will go and say: Come, and let us go up to the mountain of the Lord and to the house of the God of Iakob, and he will announce his way to us, and we will walk in it; for a law will go out from Sion, and a word of the Lord from Ierusalem.

4 And he will judge between the nations and reprove a numerous people, and they will beat their swords into plows and their spears into sickles, and nation will no longer take a sword against nation, and they will certainly no longer learn to wage war.

5 And now, house of Iakob, come, let us walk in the light of the Lord.

6 For he abandoned his people, the house of Israel, because their region was filled, as from the beginning, with divinations like that of the foreigners, and many foreign children came to be for them.

7 For their region was filled with silver and gold, and there was no number to their treasures; and the land was filled with horses, and there was no number to their chariots;

8 and the land was filled with abominations, the works of their hands, and they bowed down to what their fingers made;

9 and a man bowed and a man was humbled, and I will certainly not release them.

10 And now enter the rocks and hide in the earth before the fear of the Lord and the glory of his strength, when he rises to shatter the earth.

11 For the eyes of the Lord are high, but man is lowly; and the height of men will be humbled, and the Lord alone will be raised on that day.

12 For a day of the Lord Sabaoth is against every arrogant and proud one and against every high and lofty one, and they will be humbled,

13 and against every cedar of Lebanon among the high and lofty ones, and against every acorn tree of Basan,

14 and against every mountain and against every high hill,

15 and against every high tower and against every high wall,

16 and against every ship of the sea and against every sight of beautiful ships;

17 and every man will be humbled, and the height of men will fall, and the Lord alone will be raised on that day.

18 And they will conceal all the handmade things,

19 bringing them into the caves and into the clefts of the rocks and into the holes of the earth, before the fear of the Lord and the glory of his strength, when he rises to shatter the earth.

20 For on that day a man will cast out his silver and gold abominations which they made to worship, to vain things and to bats,

21 to enter the holes of the solid rock and the clefts of the rocks, before the fear of the Lord and the glory of his strength, when he rises to shatter the earth.

Chapter 3

1 Behold now, the Master, the Lord Sabaoth, will remove from Ioudaia and from Ierusalem a strong man and a strong woman, strength of bread and strength of water,

2 a giant and a strong one and a warrior man and a judge and a prophet and a conjecturer and an elder,

3 and a commander of fifty and a marvelous counselor and a wise master builder and an understanding hearer;

4 and I will appoint young men as their rulers, and mockers will lord over them.

5 And the people will collide, man against man and man against his neighbor; the child will clash with the old man, the dishonored with the honored.

6 For a man will take hold of his brother or his father's relative, saying: You have a garment; become our leader, and let my food be under you.

7 And answering, he will say on that day: I will not be your leader; for there is neither bread nor a garment in my house; I will not be leader of this people.

8 For Ierusalem has been abandoned, and Ioudaia has collapsed, and their tongues are with lawlessness, disobeying in things toward the Lord; for now their glory was humbled,

9 and the shame of their face opposed them; but they announced their sin like that of Sodoma and made it manifest. Woe to their soul, because they have planned an evil plan against themselves,

10 saying: Let us bind the righteous one, because he is inconvenient to us; therefore they will eat the produce of their works.

11 Woe to the lawless one; evil things according to the works of his hands will happen to him.

12 My people, your collectors glean you, and those exacting payment lord over you; my people, those calling you blessed lead you astray and trouble the path of your feet.

13 But now the Lord will take his stand for judgment and set his people for judgment;

14 the Lord himself will come to judgment with the elders of the people and with its rulers: But why did you burn my vineyard, and the plunder of the poor is in your houses?

15 Why do you wrong my people and put the face of the poor to shame?

16 Thus says the Lord: Because the daughters of Sion were exalted and walked with a high neck and with gestures of eyes, and in the going of their feet were dragging their tunics and playing with their feet together,

17 God will also humble ruling daughters of Sion, and the Lord will uncover their form

18 on that day, and the Lord will remove the glory of their clothing and their ornaments and their braided ornaments and their fringes and their crescent ornaments,

19 and the necklace and the ornament of their face,

20 and the arrangement of glorious adornment and the armlets and the bracelets and the braided ornament and the wristbands and the rings and the earrings,

21 and the purple-bordered garments and the garments purple in the middle,

22 and the coverings for the house and the transparent Laconian garments,

23 and the fine linen and the hyacinth-colored and the scarlet things and the fine linen interwoven with gold and hyacinth, and flowing summer coverings.

24 And instead of a sweet scent there will be dust, and instead of a belt you will gird yourself with a cord, and instead of the golden ornament of the head you will have baldness because of your works, and instead of the tunic purple in the middle you will gird yourself with sackcloth.

25 And your most beautiful son whom you love will fall by a sword, and your strong ones will fall by a sword.

26 And the cases of your adornment will be humbled and mourn, and you will be left alone and dashed to the ground.

Chapter 4

1 And seven women will take hold of one man, saying, We will eat our bread and put on our garments; only let your name be called upon us; take away our reproach.

2 But on that day God will shine forth in counsel with glory upon the earth, to exalt and glorify what is left of Israel,

3 and it shall be that what remains in Sion and what is left in Ierusalem will be called holy, all those written for life in Ierusalem;

4 because the Lord will wash away the filth of the sons and daughters of Sion and cleanse the blood from their midst with a spirit of judgment and a spirit of burning.

5 And he will come, and it shall be that a cloud will shade every place of Mount Sion and all that surrounds her by day, and as smoke and as the light of a burning fire by night; with all the glory it will be covered;

6 and it will be for shade from heat and in shelter and in a hiding place from harshness and rain.

Chapter 5

1 I will indeed sing to the beloved a song of the beloved for my vineyard. A vineyard came to be for the beloved on a horn, in a fertile place.

2 And I put a fence around it and palisaded it and planted a Sorech vine and built a tower in its midst and dug a vat in it; and I waited for it to produce a grape cluster, but it produced thorns.

3 And now, man of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem, judge between me and my vineyard.

4 What shall I still do for my vineyard that I have not done for it? For I waited for it to produce a grape cluster, but it produced thorns.

5 But now I will announce to you what I will do to my vineyard: I will take away its fence, and it will be for plundering, and I will pull down its wall, and it will be for trampling,

6 and I will abandon my vineyard, and it will certainly not be pruned or dug, and a thorn will come up in it as in waste ground; and I will command the clouds not to rain rain upon it.

7 For the vineyard of the Lord Sabaoth is the house of Israel, and the man of Iouda a beloved new planting; I waited for it to do justice, but it did lawlessness, and not righteousness but an outcry.

8 Woe to those joining house to house and bringing field near to field, so that they may take something away from their neighbor; will you dwell alone upon the earth?

9 For these things were heard in the ears of the Lord Sabaoth: for if many houses come to be, great and beautiful ones will be for desolation, and there will be none dwelling in them.

10 For where ten yokes of oxen work, it will produce one jar, and the one sowing six artabas will produce three measures. —

11 Woe to those rising in the morning and pursuing sikera, those remaining late; for the wine will burn them up.

12 For they drink wine with lyre and harp and drums and pipes, but they do not look at the works of the Lord and do not consider the works of his hands.

13 Therefore my people became captive because they did not know the Lord, and there came to be a multitude of dead because of famine and thirst for water.

14 And Hades enlarged its soul and opened its mouth without ceasing, and her glorious and great and rich and pestilent ones will go down.

15 And a human will be humbled, and a man will be dishonored, and the lofty eyes will be humbled;

16 and the Lord Sabaoth will be exalted in judgment, and the holy God will be glorified in righteousness.

17 And those plundered will graze like bulls, and lambs will eat the deserted places of those taken away. —

18 Woe to those dragging sins as with a long rope, and lawless deeds as with the strap of a heifer's yoke,

19 those saying, Let what he will do draw near quickly, so that we may see, and let the counsel of the Holy One of Israel come, so that we may know. —

20 Woe to those calling evil good and good evil, those making darkness light and light darkness, those making bitter sweet and sweet bitter. —

21 Woe to those intelligent in themselves and knowledgeable before themselves. —

22 Woe to your strong ones who drink wine and the powerful ones who mix sikera,

23 those justifying the impious because of gifts and taking away the right of the righteous.

24 Therefore, in the manner that stubble will be burned by a coal of fire and burned up by a spreading flame, their root will be like chaff, and their flower will rise like dust; for they did not desire the law of the Lord Sabaoth, but provoked the utterance of the Holy One of Israel.

25 And the Lord Sabaoth was angered with wrath against his people, and he laid his hand upon them and struck them, and the mountains were provoked, and their carcasses became like dung in the midst of a road. And in all these things the fury did not turn away, but still the hand is raised.

26 Therefore he will raise a signal among the nations far away and whistle to them from the end of the earth, and behold, they come quickly, lightly;

27 they will not hunger or grow weary or doze or sleep or loosen their belts from their waist, nor will the straps of their sandals be broken;

28 whose arrows are sharp and their bows drawn, the feet of their horses were reckoned as solid rock, the wheels of their chariots as a tempest;

29 they charge like lions and have stood by like a lion's cub; and it will seize and cry out as a beast and cast out, and there will be no one rescuing them.

30 And it will cry out because of them on that day like the sound of a surging sea; and they will look toward the earth, and behold, harsh darkness in their perplexity.

Chapter 6

1 And it happened in the year in which Ozias the king died, I saw the Lord sitting upon a high and lifted throne, and the house full of his glory.

2 And seraphin stood around him, six wings to the one and six wings to the one, and with two they covered their face and with two they covered their feet and with two they flew.

3 And they cried out, one to the other, and said, Holy, holy, holy is the Lord Sabaoth; all the earth is full of his glory.

4 And the lintel was lifted by the voice with which they cried out, and the house was filled with smoke.

5 And I said, O wretched me, because I am pierced, because, being a human and having unclean lips, I dwell in the midst of a people having unclean lips, and I saw the King, the Lord Sabaoth, with my eyes.

6 And one of the seraphin was sent to me, and in its hand it had a coal, which it took with the tongs from the altar,

7 and it touched my mouth and said, Behold, this touched your lips and will take away your lawless deeds and thoroughly cleanse your sins.

8 And I heard the voice of the Lord saying, Whom shall I send, and who will go to this people? And I said, Behold, here I am; send me.

9 And he said, Go and say to this people, By hearing you will hear and certainly not understand, and looking you will look and certainly not see;

10 for the heart of this people grew thick, and with their ears they heard heavily and shut their eyes, lest they see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and turn back, and I will heal them.

11 And I said, Until when, Lord? And he said, Until cities are desolated through not being inhabited, and houses through there being no humans, and the earth will be left desolate.

12 And after these things God will remove the humans far away, and those left will be multiplied upon the earth;

13 and still upon it there is the tenth part, and again it will be for plunder, like a terebinth and like an acorn when it falls out of its casing.

Chapter 7

1 And it happened in the days of Achaz, son of Ioatham, son of Ozias, king of Iouda, Raasson king of Aram and Phakee son of Romelias, king of Israel, went up against Ierusalem to war against her, and they were not able to besiege her.

2 And it was announced to the house of David, saying, Aram has agreed with Ephraim; and his soul and the soul of his people were astounded, as when a tree in a wood is shaken by wind.

3 And the Lord said to Esaias, Go out to meet Achaz, you and the remaining Iasoub your son, toward the pool of the upper road of the fuller's field,

4 and you will say to him, Take care to be quiet and do not fear, nor let your soul be weak because of these two pieces of wood, these smoking firebrands; for when the wrath of my fury comes, I will heal again.

5 And the son of Aram and the son of Romelias, because they counseled an evil counsel concerning you, saying,

6 We will go up into Ioudaia and, speaking together with them, turn them toward us, and we will make the son of Tabeel king over her,

7 thus says the Lord Sabaoth, This counsel will certainly not endure, nor will it be;

8 but the head of Aram is Damascus, but within yet sixty-five years the kingdom of Ephraim will cease from being a people,

9 and the head of Ephraim is Somoron, and the head of Somoron the son of Romelias; and if you do not believe, you will certainly not understand either.

10 And the Lord proceeded to speak to Achaz, saying,

11 Ask for yourself a sign from the Lord your God, into depth or into height.

12 And Achaz said, I will certainly not ask, nor will I certainly test the Lord.

13 And he said, Hear indeed, house of David; is it a small thing for you to cause humans a struggle? And how do you cause the Lord a struggle?

14 Therefore the Lord himself will give you a sign: behold, the virgin will have in the womb and bear a son, and you will call his name Emmanouel;

15 he will eat butter and honey; before he knows or chooses evil things, he will choose the good;

16 because before the child knows good or bad, he disobeys wickedness so as to choose the good, and the land which you fear will be abandoned before the two kings.

17 But God will bring upon you and upon your people and upon your father's house days which have not yet come since the day he took Ephraim away from Iouda—the king of the Assyrians.

18 And it shall be on that day that the Lord will whistle to flies, that which rules a part of the river of Egypt, and to the bee which is in the country of the Assyrians,

19 and they will all come and rest in the ravines of the country and in the holes of the rocks and in the caves and in every fissure and in every tree.

20 On that day the Lord will shave with the great and drunken razor, which is beyond the river of the king of the Assyrians, the head and the hair of the feet, and he will take away the beard.

21 And it shall be on that day that a human will rear a heifer of the cattle and two sheep,

22 and it shall be that, because of the producing of very much milk, everyone left upon the earth will eat butter and honey.

23 And it shall be on that day that every place where there are a thousand vines worth a thousand shekels will become waste ground and thorns;

24 with arrow and bow they will enter there, because all the earth will be waste ground and thorns.

25 And every mountain being plowed will be plowed, and fear will certainly not come there; for from waste ground and thorns it will become a pasture for sheep and a trampling place for cattle.

Chapter 8

1 And the Lord said to me, Take for yourself a volume of a large new scroll and write in it with a human's stylus, To make a swift plundering of spoils; for it is present.

2 And make faithful humans witnesses for me, Ourias and Zacharias son of Barachias.

3 And I approached the prophetess, and she conceived in the womb and bore a son. And the Lord said to me, Call his name, Spoil quickly, plunder swiftly;

4 because before the child knows to call father or mother, he will take the power of Damascus and the spoils of Samaria before the king of the Assyrians.

5 And the Lord proceeded to speak to me again,

6 Because this people does not desire the water of Siloam which goes quietly, but desires to have Raasson and the son of Romelias as king over you,

7 therefore behold, the Lord brings up upon you the water of the river, strong and abundant, the king of the Assyrians and his glory, and it will go up upon every ravine of yours and walk upon every wall of yours,

8 and he will take away from Ioudaia a human who will be able to raise a head or one able to accomplish something, and his encampment will be such as to fill the breadth of your country; God is with us.

9 Know, nations, and be defeated; listen as far as the end of the earth; having become strong, be defeated; for if you become strong again, you will be defeated again.

10 And whatever counsel you may counsel, the Lord will scatter it, and whatever word you may speak will certainly not endure for you, because the Lord God is with us.

11 Thus says the Lord, With the strong hand they disobey the course of the way of this people, saying,

12 Never say, Hard; for everything which this people may say is hard; but you will certainly not fear its fear or be troubled;

13 sanctify the Lord himself, and he will be your fear.

14 And if you are trusting in him, he will be for you a sanctuary, and you will not encounter him as a stumbling against a stone or as a falling against a rock; but the house of Iakob is in a snare, and those sitting in Ierusalem in a hollow.

15 Therefore many among them will be powerless and will fall and be shattered, and humans who are in security will draw near and be captured.

16 Then those sealing the law so that it may not be learned will be manifest.

17 And he will say, I will wait for God, who turned his face away from the house of Iakob, and I will be trusting in him.

18 Behold, I and the children whom God gave me, and it will be for signs and wonders in the house of Israel from the Lord Sabaoth, who dwells on Mount Sion.

19 And if they say to you, Seek those speaking from the earth and the ventriloquists, those speaking empty words who speak from the belly—is not a nation toward its God? Why do they seek the dead concerning the living?

20 For he gave a law for help, so that they may speak unlike this utterance, concerning which there are no gifts to give concerning it.

21 And a harsh famine will come upon you, and it shall be that when you hunger, you will be grieved and speak evil of the ruler and the patachra, and they will look up toward heaven above

22 and look toward the earth below, and behold, affliction and confinement and darkness, constricted perplexity and darkness so as not to see,

23 and the one in confinement will not be perplexed until a time. Do this first, do it quickly, country of Zaboulon, land of Nephthalim, the way of the sea, and the remaining ones inhabiting the coast and beyond the Iordan, Galilaia of the nations, the parts of Ioudaia.

Chapter 9

1 The people walking in darkness, see a great light; those dwelling in a country and shadow of death, light will shine upon you.

2 The greatest part of the people, which you brought down in your gladness, and they will be glad before you as those glad at harvest and in the manner of those dividing spoils.

3 Because the yoke lying upon them has been taken away, and the rod upon their neck; for the Lord scattered the rod of those exacting payment, as on the day against Madiam.

4 Because they will repay every robe gathered by deceit and a garment with restitution, and they will wish that they had become burned by fire.

5 Because a child was born to us, a son was also given to us, whose rule came to be upon his shoulder, and his name is called Messenger of Great Counsel; for I will bring peace upon the rulers, peace and health to him.

6 Great is his rule, and there is no limit to his peace upon the throne of David and his kingdom, to establish it and uphold it in righteousness and in judgment from now and for eternal time; the zeal of the Lord Sabaoth will do these things.

7 The Lord sent death upon Iakob, and it came upon Israel,

8 and all the people of Ephraim and those sitting in Samaria will know, saying in insolence and a lofty heart,

9 Bricks have fallen, but come, let us hew stones and cut down sycamores and cedars and build ourselves a tower.

10 And God will dash those rising against Mount Sion upon them and scatter their enemies,

11 Syria from the rising of the sun and the Greeks from the setting of the sun, those devouring Israel with the whole mouth. In all these things the fury did not turn away, but still the hand is raised. —

12 And the people did not turn back until it was struck, and they did not seek the Lord.

13 And the Lord took away from Israel head and tail, great and small, in one day,

14 an elder and those admiring faces [this is the rule], and a prophet teaching lawless things [this is the tail].

15 And those blessing this people will be leading astray, and they lead astray so that they may swallow them.

16 Therefore God will not be glad over their young men and will not have mercy on their orphans and their widows, because all are lawless and evil, and every mouth speaks unjust things. In all these things the fury did not turn away, but still the hand is raised. —

17 And lawlessness will burn like fire and like dry grass will be eaten by fire; and it will burn in the thickets of the wood, and it will devour together everything around the hills.

18 Because of the fury of the Lord's wrath, the whole earth has been burned up, and the people will be as burned up by fire; a human will not have mercy on his brother,

19 but will turn aside to the right because he will hunger, and will eat from the left, and a human eating the flesh of his arm will certainly not be filled.

20 For Manasse will eat of Ephraim, and Ephraim of Manasse, because together they will besiege Ioudas. In all these things the fury did not turn away, but still the hand is raised. —

Chapter 10

1 Woe to those writing wickedness; for, writing, they write wickedness,

2 turning aside the justice of the poor, snatching the judgment of the needy of my people, so that a widow may be for them for seizure and an orphan for plunder.

3 And what will they do on the day of visitation? For affliction will come to you from far away; and to whom will you flee for help? And where will you leave your glory,

4 so as not to fall into calamity? In all these things the fury did not turn away, but still the hand is raised.

5 Woe to the Assyrians; the rod of my fury and wrath is in their hands.

6 I will send my wrath against a lawless nation, and I will order my people to make spoils and plunder and trample the cities and turn them into dust.

7 But he did not consider it thus and has not reckoned it thus in his soul, but his mind will turn to doing away with and destroying not a few nations.

8 And if they say to him, You alone are ruler,

9 he will also say, Did I not take the country above Babylon and Chalanne, where the tower was built? And I took Arabia and Damascus and Samaria;

10 in the manner that I took these in my hand, I will also take all the dominions. Wail, carved things in Ierusalem and in Samaria;

11 for in the manner that I did to Samaria and her handmade things, thus I will also do to Ierusalem and her idols. —

12 And it shall be, when the Lord finishes doing everything on Mount Sion and in Ierusalem, he will bring it upon the great mind, the ruler of the Assyrians, and upon the height of the glory of his eyes.

13 For he said, By strength I will do it, and by the wisdom of understanding; I will take away the boundaries of nations and plunder their strength and shake inhabited cities,

14 and I will seize the whole inhabited world with my hand like a nest and lift it like abandoned eggs, and there is no one who will escape me or contradict me.

15 Will an axe be glorified without the one cutting with it? Or will a saw be exalted without the one pulling it? Likewise, if someone lifts a rod or a piece of wood.

16 And not thus, but the Lord Sabaoth will send dishonor into your honor, and into your glory a burning fire will burn;

17 and the light of Israel will become fire, and he will sanctify him in burning fire and eat the woodland like grass. On that day

18 the mountains and hills and woods will be extinguished, and it will devour from soul to flesh; and the one fleeing will be like the one fleeing from a burning flame;

19 and those left of them will be a number, and a child will write them.

20 And it shall be on that day that what is left of Israel will no longer continue, and those saved of Iakob will certainly no longer be trusting in those who wronged them, but they will be trusting in God, the Holy One of Israel, in truth,

21 and what is left of Iakob will be toward a strong God.

22 And if the people Israel become like the sand of the sea, their remnant will be saved; for, completing and cutting short a word in righteousness,

23 because God will do a word cut short in the whole inhabited world.

24 Therefore thus says the Lord Sabaoth, Do not fear, my people, those dwelling in Sion, because of the Assyrians, because he will strike you with a rod; for I bring a blow upon you to see the way of Egypt.

25 For yet a little while and the wrath will cease, but my fury will be against their counsel;

26 and God will raise up against them according to the blow against Madiam in a place of affliction, and his fury by the way along the sea into the way toward Egypt.

27 And it shall be on that day that his fear will be taken away from you and his yoke from your shoulder, and the yoke will be destroyed from your shoulders.

28 For he will come into the city Aggai and pass into Magedo and place his equipment in Machmas;

29 and he will pass a ravine and come into Aggai; fear will seize Rama, the city of Saoul; she will flee,

30 the daughter of Gallim; Laisa will listen; Anathoth will listen;

31 Madebena was astounded, and those dwelling in Gibbir; encourage

32 today on the way to remain; with the hand encourage the mountain, the daughter Sion, and the hills in Ierusalem.

33 For behold, the Master, the Lord Sabaoth, throws the glorious ones into turmoil with strength, and the lofty in insolence will be shattered, and the lofty will be humbled,

34 and the lofty will fall by a sword, and Lebanon will fall with the lofty.

Chapter 11

1 And a rod will come forth from the root of Iessai, and a flower will come up from the root.

2 And the spirit of God will rest upon him, a spirit of wisdom and understanding, a spirit of counsel and strength, a spirit of knowledge and piety;

3 a spirit of the fear of God will fill him. He will not judge according to appearance or reprove according to talk,

4 but he will judge a judgment for a humble one and reprove the humble of the earth; and he will strike the earth with the word of his mouth and with a breath through his lips kill an impious one;

5 and he will be girded at his waist with righteousness and wrapped at his sides with truth.

6 And a wolf will graze together with a lamb, and a leopard will rest together with a kid, and a calf and a bull and a lion will graze together, and a small child will lead them;

7 and an ox and a bear will graze together, and their children will be together, and a lion and an ox will eat straw together.

8 And an infant child will put its hand upon a hole of asps and upon a bed of the offspring of asps.

9 And they will certainly not do evil or be able to destroy anyone upon my holy mountain, because the whole earth was filled with knowing the Lord, as much water covers seas.

10 And it shall be on that day that the root of Iessai and the one rising to rule nations—in him nations will hope, and his rest will be honor.

11 And it shall be on that day that the Lord will proceed to show his hand, to be zealous for the remaining remnant of the people, whatever may be left from the Assyrians and from Egypt and Babylonia and Ethiopia and from the Ailamites and from the rising of the sun and from Arabia.

12 And he will raise a sign to the nations and gather the lost ones of Israel, and he will gather the scattered ones of Iouda from the four wings of the earth.

13 And the jealousy of Ephraim will be taken away, and the enemies of Iouda will perish; Ephraim will not be jealous of Ioudas, and Ioudas will not afflict Ephraim.

14 And they will fly in ships of foreigners over the sea; together they will plunder both those from the rising of the sun and Idoumaia; and upon Moab they will first lay their hands, and the sons of Ammon will first obey.

15 And the Lord will desolate the sea of Egypt and lay his hand upon the river with a violent wind and strike seven ravines so that one may pass through it in sandals;

16 and there will be a passage for my people left in Egypt, and it will be for Israel like the day when it came out of the land of Egypt.

Chapter 12

1 And you will say on that day, I will bless you, Lord, because you were angry with me and turned away your fury and had mercy on me.

2 Behold, my God, my Savior, is the Lord; I will be trusting in him and will be saved in him and will not fear, because the Lord is my glory and my praise, and he became salvation for me.

3 And you will draw water with gladness from the springs of salvation.

4 And you will say on that day, Hymn the Lord, cry out his name, announce his glorious things among the nations, remember that his name was exalted.

5 Hymn the name of the Lord, because he did lofty things; announce these things in all the earth.

6 Exult and be glad, those dwelling in Sion, because the Holy One of Israel was exalted in her midst.

Chapter 13

1 A vision which Esaias son of Amos saw against Babylon.

2 Upon a level mountain raise a sign; lift the voice to them; do not fear; encourage with the hand, Open, rulers.

3 I give orders, and I lead them; they are sanctified, and I lead them; giants come to fulfill my fury, rejoicing together and acting insolently.

4 A sound of many nations upon the mountains, like many nations, a sound of kings and nations gathered together. The Lord Sabaoth has commanded an armed fighting nation

5 to come from a land far away, from the end of the foundation of heaven, the Lord and his armed fighters, to destroy the whole inhabited world.

6 Wail, for the day of the Lord is near, and destruction will come from God.

7 Therefore every hand will be slackened, and every human soul will be cowardly;

8 and the elders will be troubled, and pangs will hold them like those of a woman giving birth; and they will lament to one another and be astounded and change their face like a flame.

9 For behold, an incurable day of the Lord comes, of fury and wrath, to make the whole inhabited world desolate and destroy the sinners from it.

10 For the stars of heaven and Orion and all the adornment of heaven will not give light, and it will be darkened as the sun rises, and the moon will not give her light.

11 And I will command evils for the whole inhabited world and their sins for the impious; and I will destroy the insolence of the lawless and humble the insolence of the proud.

12 And those left will be more precious than unfired gold, and the human will be more precious than the stone from Souphir.

13 For heaven will be angered, and the earth will be shaken from her foundations because of the fury of the wrath of the Lord Sabaoth on the day when his fury comes upon it.

14 And those left will be like a fleeing little gazelle and like a wandering sheep, and there will be no one gathering, so that a human turns back to his people and a human hastens to his country.

15 For whoever is captured will be defeated, and whoever are gathered will fall by a sword;

16 and they will dash their children before them and plunder their houses and have their wives.

17 Behold, I raise up against you the Medes, who do not reckon silver or have need of gold.

18 They will shatter young men's bows and will certainly not have mercy on your children, nor will their eyes spare the children.

19 And Babylon, which is called glorious by the king of the Chaldeans, will be as when God overturned Sodoma and Gomorra;

20 she will not be inhabited for eternal time, nor will they enter her through many generations, nor will Arabs pass through her, nor will shepherds rest in her;

21 and beasts will rest there, and the houses will be filled with noise, and sirens will rest there, and demons will dance there,

22 and donkey-centaurs will dwell there, and hedgehogs will make nests in their houses; it comes quickly and will not delay.

Chapter 14

1 And the Lord will have mercy on Iakob and will yet choose Israel, and they will rest upon their land, and the sojourner will be added to them and will be added to the house of Iakob,

2 and nations will take them and bring them into their place, and they will inherit and be multiplied upon God's land as male slaves and female slaves; and those who took them captive will be captives, and those who ruled them will be ruled.

3 And it shall be on that day that God will give you rest from the pain and your fury and your harsh slavery, in which you served them.

4 And you will take up this lament over the king of Babylon and say on that day, How has the one exacting payment rested, and the taskmaster rested?

5 God shattered the yoke of sinners, the yoke of rulers;

6 having struck a nation in fury with an incurable blow, beating a nation with a blow of fury which did not spare,

7 he rested in confidence. All the earth cries out with gladness,

8 and the trees of Lebanon were glad over you, and the cedar of Lebanon: Since you have fallen asleep, the one cutting us has not come up.

9 Hades below was embittered, meeting you; all the giants who ruled the earth were raised up together for you, those raising all kings of nations from their thrones.

10 All will answer and say to you, You too were captured, just as we were, and you were reckoned among us.

11 But your glory went down into Hades, your abundant gladness; below you they will spread decay, and your covering is a worm.

12 How did the dawn-bearer who rises in the morning fall from heaven? The one sending to all the nations was shattered to the earth.

13 But you said in your mind, I will go up into heaven; above the stars of heaven I will place my throne; I will sit on a high mountain, upon the high mountains toward the north;

14 I will go up above the clouds; I will be like the Most High.

15 But now you will go down into Hades and into the foundations of the earth.

16 Those seeing you will marvel at you and say, Is this the human who provokes the earth, shaking kings?

17 The one who made the whole inhabited world desolate and pulled down the cities did not release those in calamity.

18 All the kings of the nations fell asleep in honor, each human in his house;

19 but you will be thrown in the mountains like an abhorred corpse with many dead, pierced by swords, going down into Hades. In the manner that a garment stained with blood will not be clean,

20 thus neither will you be clean, because you destroyed my land and killed my people; you will certainly not remain for eternal time, evil seed.

21 Prepare your children to be slaughtered for the sins of your father, so that they may not rise and inherit the earth and fill the earth with cities.

22 And I will rise against them, says the Lord Sabaoth, and destroy their name and remnant and seed—thus says the Lord—

23 and I will make Babylonia desolate so that hedgehogs dwell there, and she will become nothing; and I will make her a pit of mud for destruction. —

24 Thus says the Lord Sabaoth, In the manner that I have spoken, thus it will be, and in the manner that I have counseled, thus it will remain,

25 to destroy the Assyrians from my land and from my mountains, and they will be for trampling, and their yoke will be taken away from them, and their renown will be taken away from the shoulders.

26 This is the counsel which the Lord has counseled against the whole inhabited world, and this the raised hand against all the nations of the inhabited world.

27 For what the holy God has counseled, who will scatter it? And who will turn back the raised hand?

28 In the year in which Achaz the king died, this utterance came to be.

29 Do not be glad, all you foreigners, because the yoke of the one beating you was shattered; for from the seed of snakes will come offspring of asps, and their offspring will come forth as flying snakes.

30 And poor people will graze through him, and poor men will rest in peace; but he will kill your seed by famine and kill your remnant.

31 Wail, gates of cities; let troubled cities cry out, all the foreigners, because smoke comes from the north, and there is no remaining.

32 And what will kings of nations answer? That the Lord founded Sion, and through him the humble of the people will be saved.

Chapter 15

1 The utterance against Moabitis. At night Moabitis will perish, for at night the wall of Moabitis will perish.

2 Be grieved for yourselves, for Debon too will perish; where your altar is, there you will go up to weep; over Nabau of Moabitis wail—baldness upon every head, all arms cut;

3 in her squares gird yourselves with sackcloth and beat yourselves; upon her roofs and in her streets all wail with weeping.

4 Because Esebon and Eleale have cried out, their voice was heard as far as Iassa; therefore the waist of Moabitis cries out; her soul will know.

5 The heart of Moabitis cries out within her as far as Segor, for she is a three-year-old heifer; but on the ascent of Louith they will go up toward you weeping; on the road of Aroniim destruction and shaking cry out.

6 The water of Nemrim will be desolate, and her grass will cease; for there will be no green grass.

7 Will she perhaps be saved even thus? For I will bring Arabs against the ravine, and they will take her.

8 For the cry reached the boundary of Moabitis, of Agallim, and her wailing as far as the well of Ailim.

9 But the water of Remmon will be filled with blood; for I will bring Arabs upon Remmon and take away the seed of Moab and Ariel and the remnant of Adama.

Chapter 16

1 I will send like creeping things upon the earth; is Mount Sion not a desolate rock?

2 For you will be like a removed chick of a flying bird, daughter of Moab. But then, Arnon,

3 counsel more; make a shelter of mourning for her continually; in midday darkness they flee; they were astounded; do not be carried away.

4 The fugitives of Moab will sojourn with you; they will be a shelter for you from the face of a pursuer, because your alliance was taken away, and the ruler who tramples upon the earth perished.

5 And a throne will be established with mercy, and he will sit upon it with truth in the tent of David, judging and seeking judgment and hastening righteousness.

6 We heard the insolence of Moab—exceedingly insolent; you raised up pride. Your divination is not thus,

7 not thus. Moab will wail, for in Moabitis all will wail; you will meditate for those dwelling in Deseth and will not be ashamed.

8 You will mourn the plains of Esebon, vine of Sebama; swallowing the nations, trample her vines as far as Iazer; you will certainly not reach; wander the desert; those sent were abandoned, for they crossed the desert.

9 Therefore I will weep as with the weeping of Iazer for the vine of Sebama; he cast down your trees, Esebon and Eleale, because at your harvest and at your vintage I will trample, and everything will fall.

10 And gladness and exultation will be taken away from your vineyards, and in your vineyards they will certainly not be glad or tread wine into the vats, for it has ceased.

11 Therefore my belly will sound over Moab like a lyre, and my inward parts like a wall which you renewed.

12 And it will result in your being ashamed, because Moab grew weary upon the altars, and she will enter her handmade things to pray, and it will certainly not be able to deliver him.

13 This is the utterance which the Lord spoke against Moab, whenever he also spoke it.

14 And now I say, Within three years, years of a hired worker, the glory of Moab will be dishonored with all the abundant wealth, and he will be left very small and not honored.

Chapter 17

1 The utterance against Damascus. Behold, Damascus will be removed from among cities and will become a ruin,

2 abandoned forever, a bed and resting place for flocks, and there will be no pursuer.

3 And there will no longer be a stronghold for Ephraim to flee to, and there will no longer be a kingdom in Damascus, and the remainder of the Syrians will perish; for you are not better than the sons of Israel and their glory; thus says the Lord Sabaoth.

4 On that day there will be a failing of the glory of Iakob, and the fat things of his glory will be shaken.

5 And it will be as when someone gathers a standing harvest and reaps the seed of ears in his arm, and it will be as when someone gathers an ear in a solid ravine

6 and stubble is left in it, or as two or three olive berries are left upon a lofty top, or four or five upon their branches; thus says the Lord, the God of Israel.

7 On that day a human will be trusting in the one who made him, and his eyes will look toward the Holy One of Israel,

8 and they will certainly not be trusting in the altars or in the works of their hands which their fingers made, and they will not see their trees or their abominations.

9 On that day your cities will be abandoned, in the manner that the Amorraians and the Euaians abandoned them before the sons of Israel, and they will be desolate,

10 because you abandoned God your Savior and did not remember the Lord your helper. Therefore you will plant an unfaithful planting and unfaithful seed;

11 but on the day when you plant, you will be led astray; and in the morning, if you sow, it will flower for a harvest on whatever day you allot, and as a human's father you will allot to your sons.

12 Woe, multitude of many nations; like a surging sea, thus you will be troubled, and the back of many nations will sound like water.

13 Like much water are many nations, like much water borne down violently; and he will drive him away and pursue him far away like chaff of straw from those winnowing before wind, and like dust of a wheel borne by a tempest.

14 Toward evening there will be mourning; before morning it will also be no more. This is the portion of those who plundered you and an inheritance for those who inherited you.

Chapter 18

1 Woe, wings of a land of ships beyond rivers of Ethiopia,

2 the one sending hostages on the sea and papyrus letters upon the water; for swift messengers will go to a lofty nation and a strange and harsh people—who is beyond it?—a hopeless and trampled nation. Now the rivers of the land,

3 all like an inhabited country; their country will be inhabited; as though a sign is raised from a mountain, like the sound of a trumpet it will be audible.

4 Because thus the Lord said to me, There will be security in my city like the light of midday heat, and it will be like a cloud of dew on a harvest day.

5 Before the harvest, when a flower is completed and an unripe grape flowers a flower, becoming an unripe grape, he will also take away the small clusters with sickles and take away and cut down the vine shoots

6 and leave them together to the birds of heaven and to the beasts of the earth, and the birds of heaven will be gathered upon them, and all the beasts of the earth will come upon him.

7 At that time gifts will be brought up to the Lord Sabaoth from an afflicted and plucked people and from a great people from now and for eternal time, a hoping and trampled nation, which is in a part of the river of its country, to the place where the name of the Lord Sabaoth was called upon, Mount Sion.

Chapter 19

1 A vision of Egypt. Behold, the Lord sits upon a light cloud and will come into Egypt, and the handmade things of Egypt will be shaken before him, and their heart will be defeated within them.

2 And Egyptians will be raised against Egyptians, and a human will war against his brother and a human against his neighbor, city against city and district against district.

3 And the spirit of the Egyptians will be troubled within them, and I will scatter their counsel, and they will inquire of their gods and their images and those speaking from the earth and the ventriloquists.

4 And I will deliver Egypt into the hands of humans, harsh masters, and harsh kings will rule them; thus says the Lord Sabaoth.

5 And the Egyptians will drink the water beside the sea, but the river will fail and dry up;

6 and the rivers and the channels of the river will fail, and every gathering of water will dry up, also in every marsh of reed and papyrus;

7 and all the green achi around the river and everything sown through the river will dry up, destroyed by wind.

8 And the fishermen will groan, and all those casting a hook into the river will groan, and those casting dragnets and those casting nets will mourn.

9 And shame will seize those working the split flax and those working the fine linen,

10 and those warping them will be in pain, and all those making beer will be grieved and suffer in their souls.

11 And the rulers of Tanis will be foolish; the wise counselors of the king—their counsel will be made foolish. How will you say to the king, We are sons of intelligent ones, sons of kings from the beginning?

12 Where are your wise ones now? And let them announce to you and say what the Lord Sabaoth has counseled against Egypt.

13 The rulers of Tanis failed, and the rulers of Memphis were exalted, and they will lead Egypt astray by tribes.

14 For the Lord mixed for them a spirit of wandering, and they led Egypt astray in all their works, as one who is drunk and vomiting together wanders.

15 And there will be no work for the Egyptians which will make head and tail, beginning and end.

16 But on that day the Egyptians will be like women in fear and trembling before the hand of the Lord Sabaoth which he himself will lay upon them.

17 And the country of the Ioudaians will be a terror to the Egyptians; everyone who may name it to them—they will fear because of the counsel which the Lord has counseled against her. —

18 On that day there will be five cities in Egypt speaking in the Chanaanite tongue and swearing by the name of the Lord; the one city will be called City-Asedek. —

19 On that day there will be an altar to the Lord in the country of the Egyptians and a pillar toward her boundary to the Lord,

20 and it will be a sign forever to the Lord in the country of Egypt, because they will cry out to the Lord because of those afflicting them, and the Lord will send them a human who will save them; judging, he will save them.

21 And the Lord will be known to the Egyptians, and the Egyptians will know the Lord on that day and make sacrifices and vow vows to the Lord and pay them.

22 And the Lord will strike the Egyptians with a great blow and heal them with healing, and they will turn to the Lord, and he will listen to them and heal them. —

23 On that day there will be a road from Egypt to the Assyrians, and Assyrians will enter Egypt, and Egyptians will go to the Assyrians, and the Egyptians will serve the Assyrians. —

24 On that day Israel will be third among the Assyrians and among the Egyptians, blessed in the land,

25 which the Lord Sabaoth blessed, saying, Blessed is my people in Egypt and among the Assyrians and my inheritance Israel.

Chapter 20

1 In the year when Tanathan entered Azotos, when he was sent by Arna king of the Assyrians and warred against Azotos and seized her,

2 then the Lord spoke to Esaias, saying, Go and take away the sackcloth from your waist and unfasten your sandals from your feet; and he did thus, going naked and barefoot.

3 And the Lord said, In the manner that Esaias my servant has gone naked and barefoot three years, there will be signs and wonders for the Egyptians and Ethiopians;

4 because thus the king of the Assyrians will lead the captivity of Egypt and of the Ethiopians, young men and elders, naked and barefoot, uncovered—the shame of Egypt.

5 And the Egyptians will be ashamed, defeated, over the Ethiopians in whom the Egyptians had been trusting, for they were a glory to them.

6 And those dwelling on this island will say, Behold, we had been trusting in fleeing to them for help, who were not able to be saved from the king of the Assyrians; and how will we be saved?

Chapter 21

1 The vision of the desert. As a tempest might pass through a desert, coming from a desert, from a land, fearful

2 and harsh was the vision announced to me. The one setting aside sets aside; the one acting lawlessly acts lawlessly. Against me are the Ailamites, and the elders of the Persians come against me. Now I will groan and comfort myself.

3 Therefore my waist was filled with weakness, and pangs took me like a woman giving birth; I did wrong so as not to hear; I was eager not to see.

4 My heart wanders, and lawlessness immerses me; my soul has come to fear.

5 Prepare the table; drink, eat; rising, rulers, prepare shields.

6 Because thus the Lord said to me, Going, station a watchman for yourself and announce whatever you see;

7 and I saw riders, two horsemen, a rider of a donkey and a rider of a camel. Listen with much listening,

8 and call Ourias to the Lord's lookout. And he said, I stood continually by day, and I stood at the encampment the whole night,

9 and behold, he himself comes, a rider of a pair of horses. And answering, he said, Babylon has fallen, and all her images and her handmade things were shattered to the earth.

10 Hear, those left and those suffering pain; hear what I heard from the Lord Sabaoth; the God of Israel announced it to us.

11 The vision of Idoumaia. To me he calls from Seir, Guard the battlements.

12 I guard the morning and the night; if you seek, seek and dwell with me;

13 in the wood at evening you will sleep on the road of Daidan.

14 Bring water to meet a thirsty one, those dwelling in the country of Thaiman; meet the fugitives with bread,

15 because of the multitude of those fleeing and because of the multitude of those wandering and because of the multitude of the sword and because of the multitude of the drawn bows and because of the multitude of those fallen in the war.

16 Because thus the Lord said to me, Yet a year, like a hired worker's year, and the glory of the sons of Kedar will cease,

17 and the remainder of the bows of the strong sons of Kedar will be few, because the Lord, the God of Israel, spoke.

Chapter 22

1 The utterance of the ravine of Sion. What happened to you now, that you all went up to roofs,

2 empty ones? The city was filled with those shouting; your wounded are not wounded by a sword, nor are your dead dead in war.

3 All your rulers have fled, and those captured are harshly bound, and the strong among you have fled far away.

4 Therefore I said, Leave me; I will weep bitterly; do not strive to comfort me over the destruction of the daughter of my race.

5 Because it is a day of trouble and destruction and trampling and wandering from the Lord Sabaoth in the ravine of Sion; they wander from small to great; they wander upon the mountains.

6 And the Ailamites took quivers, humans riding upon horses and a gathering of a battle formation.

7 And it shall be that your chosen ravines will be filled with chariots, and the horsemen will block your gates;

8 and they will uncover the gates of Iouda and look on that day toward the chosen houses of the city,

9 and they will uncover the hidden things of the houses of the citadel of David. And they saw that they are more numerous and that they turned the water of the old pool into the city

10 and that they pulled down the houses of Ierusalem for a fortification of the wall for the city.

11 And you made water for yourselves between the two walls, inward of the old pool, and you did not look toward the one who made her from the beginning and did not see the one who created her.

12 And the Lord Sabaoth called on that day for weeping and beating and shaving and girding with sackcloth,

13 but they made gladness and exultation, slaughtering calves and sacrificing sheep so as to eat meat and drink wine, saying, Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die.

14 And these things have been uncovered in the ears of the Lord Sabaoth, that this sin will not be forgiven you until you die.

15 Thus says the Lord Sabaoth, Go into the temple chamber to Somnas the treasurer and say to him,

16 What are you here, and what is there for you here, that you hewed yourself a tomb here and made yourself a tomb in a high place and inscribed yourself a tent in a rock?

17 Behold indeed, the Lord Sabaoth will cast out and crush a man and take away your robe

18 and your glorious crown and throw you into a great and immeasurable country, and there you will die; and he will put your beautiful chariot into dishonor and your ruler's house into trampling,

19 and you will be removed from your stewardship and from your station.

20 And it shall be on that day that I will call my servant Eliakim, the son of Chelkias,

21 and clothe him in your robe and give him your crown, and I will give your might and stewardship into his hands, and he will be like a father to those dwelling in Ierusalem and those dwelling in Iouda.

22 And I will give him the glory of David, and he will rule, and there will be no one contradicting.

23 And I will station him as ruler in a faithful place, and he will be a throne of glory for the house of his father.

24 And every glorious one in the house of his father will be trusting in him, from small to great, and they will be hanging upon him.

25 On that day—thus says the Lord Sabaoth—the human established in a faithful place will be moved and will fall, and the glory upon him will be taken away, because the Lord spoke.

Chapter 23

1 The vision of Tyre. Wail, ships of Carthage, because she perished, and they no longer come from the land of the Kitiaians; she has been led captive.

2 To whom have those dwelling on the island become like, merchants of Phoinike crossing the sea

3 in much water, seed of merchants? Like a harvest being brought in are the merchants of the nations.

4 Be ashamed, Sidon, the sea said; and the strength of the sea said, I did not labor in birth or give birth or rear young men or raise up virgins.

5 But when it becomes heard in Egypt, pain will seize them concerning Tyre.

6 Go away into Carthage; wail, those dwelling on this island.

7 Was this not your insolence from the beginning, before she was delivered over?

8 Who counseled these things against Tyre? Is she inferior or without strength? Her merchants are glorious, rulers of the earth.

9 The Lord Sabaoth counseled to loosen all the insolence of the glorious ones and dishonor every glorious thing upon the earth.

10 Work your land, for ships no longer come from Carthage either.

11 And your hand no longer has strength over the sea, the one provoking kings; the Lord Sabaoth commanded concerning Chanaan to destroy her strength.

12 And they will say, You will certainly no longer continue to act insolently and wrong the daughter of Sidon; and if you go away to the Kitieis, not even there will there be rest for you;

13 and into the land of the Chaldeans—this too has been desolated by the Assyrians—not even there will there be rest for you, because her wall has fallen.

14 Wail, ships of Carthage, because your stronghold perished.

15 And it shall be on that day that Tyre will be abandoned seventy years, like the time of a king, like the time of a human; and it shall be after seventy years that Tyre will be like a prostitute's song:

16 Take a lyre, wander cities, forgotten prostitute; play the lyre well, sing much, so that a remembrance of you may come to be.

17 And it shall be after seventy years that God will make a visitation of Tyre, and she will again be restored to the former state and will be a trading place for all the kingdoms of the inhabited world.

18 And her trade and wage will be holy to the Lord; it will not be gathered for themselves, but all her trade will be for those dwelling before the Lord, to eat and drink and be filled, for a contribution, a memorial before the Lord.

Chapter 24

1 Behold, the Lord destroys the inhabited world and will desolate her and uncover her face and scatter those dwelling in her.

2 And the people will be like the priest, and the servant like the master, and the maidservant like the mistress; the buyer will be like the seller, and the lender like the borrower, and the debtor like the one to whom he owes.

3 With destruction the earth will be destroyed, and with plunder the earth will be plundered; for the mouth of the Lord spoke these things.

4 The earth mourned, and the inhabited world was destroyed; the lofty of the earth mourned.

5 But the earth acted lawlessly because of those dwelling in her, because they transgressed the law and changed the ordinances, an eternal covenant.

6 Therefore a curse will eat the earth, because those dwelling in her sinned; therefore those dwelling in the earth will be poor, and few humans will be left.

7 Wine will mourn, a vine will mourn, all those gladdening the soul will groan.

8 The gladness of drums has ceased, the self-will and wealth of the impious have ceased, the sound of a lyre has ceased.

9 They were ashamed; they did not drink wine; sikera became bitter to those drinking.

10 Every city was desolated; he will shut a house so that no one enters.

11 Wail concerning the wine everywhere; all the gladness of the earth has ceased.

12 And cities will be left desolate, and abandoned houses will perish.

13 All these things will be in the earth in the midst of the nations; in the manner that someone gleans an olive tree, thus they will glean them, and if the vintage ceases.

14 These will cry out with a voice, and those left upon the earth will be glad together with the glory of the Lord. The water of the sea will be troubled;

15 therefore the glory of the Lord will be in the islands of the sea; the name of the Lord will be glorious: Lord, the God of Israel.

16 From the wings of the earth we heard wonders: Hope for the pious. And they will say, Woe to those setting aside, those setting aside the law.

17 Fear and pit and snare are upon you who dwell upon the earth;

18 and it shall be that the one fleeing fear will fall into the pit, and the one coming out of the pit will be captured by the snare, because windows from heaven were opened, and the foundations of the earth will be shaken.

19 With trouble the earth will be troubled, and with perplexity the earth will be perplexed;

20 the earth inclined and will be shaken like a fruit watchman's hut, like one drunk and hung over, and will fall and certainly not be able to rise, for lawlessness prevailed upon her.

21 And God will bring the hand upon the adornment of heaven and upon the kings of the earth;

22 and they will gather and shut them into a stronghold and into a prison; after many generations there will be a visitation of them.

23 And the brick will melt, and the wall will fall, because the Lord will reign in Sion and in Ierusalem and will be glorified before the elders.

Chapter 25

1 Lord my God, I will glorify you, I will hymn your name, because you did wonderful deeds, an ancient true counsel; may it be, Lord.

2 Because you made cities into a mound, strong cities so that their foundations fall; a city of the impious will certainly not be built forever.

3 Therefore the poor people will bless you, and cities of humans being wronged will bless you;

4 for you became a helper to every humble city and a shelter to those discouraged because of want; you will rescue them from evil humans, a shelter for the thirsty and a breath for humans being wronged.

5 They will bless you like fainthearted humans thirsting in Sion because of impious humans to whom you delivered us.

6 And the Lord Sabaoth will do it for all the nations upon this mountain. They will drink gladness, they will drink wine, they will anoint themselves with ointment.

7 On this mountain deliver all these things to the nations; for this counsel is against all the nations.

8 Death swallowed, having prevailed, and again God took away every tear from every face; he took away the reproach of the people from all the earth, for the mouth of the Lord spoke.

9 And they will say on that day, Behold, our God in whom we hoped and exulted, and we will be glad at our salvation.

10 Because God will give rest upon this mountain, and Moabitis will be trampled, in the manner that they tread a threshing floor with wagons;

11 and he will relax his hands, in the manner that he himself also humbled to destroy, and he will humble his insolence over the things on which he laid his hands;

12 and he will humble the height of the refuge of your wall, and it will go down as far as the ground.

Chapter 26

1 On that day they will sing this song upon the land of Iouda, saying, Behold, a strong city, and our salvation will set a wall and an outer wall.

2 Open gates; let a people enter, guarding righteousness and guarding truth,

3 upholding truth and guarding peace. Because in you

4 they hoped, Lord, forever, the great, eternal God,

5 who, humbling, brought down those dwelling in lofty places; you will cast down strong cities and bring them down as far as the ground,

6 and feet of gentle and humble ones will tread them.

7 The way of the pious became straight, and the way of the pious is prepared.

8 For the way of the Lord is judgment; we hoped in your name and in the remembrance

9 which our soul desires. From night my spirit rises early toward you, God, because your ordinances are light upon the earth. Learn righteousness, those dwelling upon the earth.

10 For the impious one has ceased; he will certainly not learn righteousness upon the earth; he will certainly not do truth; let the impious one be taken away so that he may not see the glory of the Lord.

11 Lord, your arm is raised, and they did not know, but knowing, they will be ashamed; zeal will seize an undisciplined people, and now fire will eat the adversaries. —

12 Lord our God, give us peace, for you repaid everything to us.

13 Lord our God, acquire us; Lord, apart from you we do not know another; we name your name.

14 But the dead will certainly not see life, nor will physicians raise them; therefore you brought upon them and destroyed and took away every male of theirs.

15 Add evils to them, Lord; add evils to all the glorious ones of the earth.

16 Lord, in affliction I remembered you; in little affliction your discipline was for us.

17 And as a woman in labor draws near to giving birth and cried out in her labor, thus we became to your beloved because of your fear, Lord.

18 We conceived in the womb and labored and gave birth; we made a spirit of your salvation upon the earth, but those dwelling upon the earth will fall.

19 The dead will rise, and those in the tombs will be raised, and those in the earth will be glad; for the dew from you is healing for them, but the earth of the impious will fall. —

20 Go, my people, enter your chambers, shut your door, hide yourself a little, a very little, until the wrath of the Lord passes;

21 for behold, the Lord from the holy place brings wrath upon those dwelling upon the earth, and the earth will uncover her blood and will not cover those killed.

Chapter 27

1 On that day God will bring the holy and great and strong sword upon the dragon, a fleeing snake, upon the dragon, a crooked snake, and will kill the dragon.

2 On that day a beautiful vineyard; a desire to lead a song against her.

3 I am a strong city, a city under siege; in vain I will water her; for she will be captured by night, and by day the wall will fall.

4 There is none that did not take hold of her; who will set me to guard stubble in a field? Because of this hostility I rejected her. Therefore because of this the Lord God did everything that he ordered. I have been burned up,

5 those dwelling in her will cry out, Let us make peace with him, let us make peace.

6 Those coming, children of Iakob—Israel will sprout and blossom, and the inhabited world will be filled with his fruit.

7 Will he not be struck thus, as he himself struck, and be killed thus, as he himself killed?

8 Fighting and reproaching, he will send them away; were you not the one meditating with a harsh spirit to kill them with a spirit of fury?

9 Therefore the lawlessness of Iakob will be taken away, and this is his blessing, when I take away his sin, when they make all the stones of the altars chopped up like fine dust; and their trees will certainly not remain, and their idols cut down like a wood far away.

10 The inhabited flock will be abandoned like a flock left behind; and it will be for a long time for grazing, and there they will rest.

11 And after a time there will not be anything green in her, because of drying up. Women coming from a spectacle, come; for it is not a people having understanding; therefore the one who made them will certainly not pity, nor will the one who formed them have mercy.

12 And it shall be on that day that the Lord will close up from the channel of the river as far as Rhinokoroura, but you gather the sons of Israel one by one.

13 And it shall be on that day that they will trumpet with the great trumpet, and those lost in the country of the Assyrians and those lost in Egypt will come and worship the Lord upon the holy mountain in Ierusalem.

Chapter 28

1 Woe to the crown of insolence, the hired workers of Ephraim; the flower fallen from glory upon the summit of the fertile mountain, those drunk without wine.

2 Behold, the fury of the Lord is strong and harsh, like hail borne down without shelter, borne down violently; like a great multitude of water dragging a country, it will make rest on the earth for the hands.

3 And the crown of insolence, the hired workers of Ephraim, will be trampled by the feet.

4 And the flower fallen from the hope of glory upon the top of the high mountain will be like an early fig; the one seeing it will desire to swallow it before taking it into his hand.

5 On that day the Lord Sabaoth will be the crown of hope, the woven crown of glory, for my people left behind;

6 they will be left with a spirit of judgment for judgment and strength, he preventing killing. —

7 For these have been led astray by wine; they were led astray because of sikera; priest and prophet were astounded because of wine; they were shaken by the drunkenness of sikera; they were led astray; this is an apparition.

8 A curse will eat this counsel; for this counsel is for the sake of greed.

9 To whom did we announce evils, and to whom did we announce a message, those weaned from milk, those drawn away from a breast?

10 Expect affliction upon affliction, hope upon hope, yet a little, yet a little,

11 because of contempt of lips, through another tongue, because they will speak to this people,

12 saying to it, This is the resting place for the hungry, and this the destruction, and they did not desire to hear.

13 And the utterance of the Lord God will be for them affliction upon affliction, hope upon hope, yet a little, yet a little, so that they may go and fall backward, and they will be endangered and shattered and captured. —

14 Therefore hear a word of the Lord, afflicted men and rulers of this people in Ierusalem:

15 Because you said, We made a covenant with Hades and agreements with death; if a borne tempest passes, it will certainly not come upon us; we made falsehood our hope, and we will be sheltered by falsehood,

16 therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, I will cast into the foundations of Sion a costly, chosen, precious cornerstone into her foundations, and the one believing in it will certainly not be put to shame.

17 And I will make judgment into hope, and my mercy into weights, and those trusting vainly in falsehood; because a tempest will certainly not pass you by,

18 will it not also take away your covenant of death? And your hope toward Hades will certainly not endure; if a borne tempest comes upon you, you will be for its trampling.

19 When it passes, it will take you; morning by morning it will pass by day, and by night there will be an evil hope; learn to hear.

20 Being confined, we cannot fight, and we ourselves are too weak for us to be gathered.

21 Like a mountain of impious ones he will rise and be in the ravine of Gabaon; with fury he will do his works, a work of bitterness; but his fury will act strangely, and his bitterness is strange.

22 And do not be glad, nor let your bonds grow strong, because I heard completed and cut-short deeds from the Lord Sabaoth which he will do upon all the earth.

23 Give ear and hear my voice; pay attention and hear my words.

24 Is the one plowing going to plow all day? Or will he prepare seed before working the earth?

25 Is it not when he levels her face that he then sows a little black cumin and cumin, and again sows wheat and barley and spelt in your boundaries?

26 And you will be disciplined by your God's judgment and be glad.

27 For black cumin is not cleansed with harshness, nor will a wagon wheel go around upon cumin, but black cumin is shaken out with a rod, and cumin

28 will be eaten with bread. For I will not be angry with you forever, nor will the voice of my bitterness trample you.

29 And these wonders came forth from the Lord Sabaoth; take counsel; exalt vain encouragement.

Chapter 29

1 Woe, city Ariel, against which David warred; gather produce year upon year, for you will eat with Moab.

2 For I will oppress Ariel, and her strength and wealth will be mine.

3 And I will encircle you like David and cast a palisade around you and set towers around you,

4 and your words will be humbled to the earth, and your words will sink into the earth; and your voice will be like those speaking from the earth, and your voice will weaken toward the ground.

5 And the wealth of the impious will be like dust from a wheel and like borne chaff, and it will be like a moment, immediately,

6 from the Lord Sabaoth; for there will be a visitation with thunder and shaking and a great voice, a borne tempest and a devouring flame of fire.

7 And the wealth of all the nations, all who campaigned against Ariel, and all those campaigning against Ierusalem and all those gathered against her and afflicting her, will be like one dreaming in sleep.

8 And they will be like those drinking and eating in sleep, and when they rise, their dream is empty, and in the manner that the thirsty one dreams as though drinking and, rising, still thirsts, and his soul hoped in emptiness, thus will be the wealth of all the nations, all who campaigned against Mount Sion.

9 Grow weak and be astounded and be hung over, not from sikera or from wine;

10 because the Lord has given you a spirit of stupor to drink and will shut their eyes and those of their prophets and their rulers, those seeing hidden things.

11 And all these utterances will be for you like the words of this sealed book, which, if they give it to a human knowing letters, saying, Read these things, he will also say, I cannot read, for it has been sealed.

12 And this book will be given into the hands of a human not knowing letters, and he will say to him, Read this; and he will say, I do not know letters.

13 And the Lord said, This people draws near to me; with their lips they honor me, but their heart is far away from me, and in vain they revere me, teaching human commands and teachings.

14 Therefore behold, I will proceed to transfer this people and will transfer them and destroy the wisdom of the wise and hide the understanding of the intelligent.

15 Woe to those making counsel deeply and not through the Lord; woe to those making counsel in secret, and their works will be in darkness, and they will say, Who has seen us, and who will know us or what we do?

16 Will you not be reckoned as the potter's clay? Will the thing formed say to the one forming it, You did not form me? Or the thing made to the one making it, You did not make me intelligently?

17 Is it not yet a little while, and Lebanon will be transferred like Mount Chermel, and Mount Chermel will be reckoned as a wood?

18 And on that day deaf ones will hear words of a book, and in darkness and in gloom the eyes of blind ones will see;

19 and poor ones will exult because of the Lord in gladness, and the hopeless among humans will be filled with gladness.

20 A lawless one failed, and a proud one perished, and those acting lawlessly in wickedness were destroyed,

21 and those making humans sin with a word; and they will make all those reproving in gates a stumbling block, and they turned aside a righteous one among unjust things.

22 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning the house of Iakob, whom he separated from Abraam, Iakob will not now be ashamed, nor will Israel now change his face;

23 but when their children see my works, because of me they will sanctify my name and sanctify the Holy One of Iakob and fear the God of Israel.

24 And those wandering in spirit will know understanding, and those grumbling will learn to obey, and stammering tongues will learn to speak peace.

Chapter 30

1 Woe, rebellious children, thus says the Lord, you made counsel not through me and agreements not through my spirit, to add sins upon sins,

2 those going to go down into Egypt, but they did not inquire of me, to be helped by Pharao and sheltered by Egyptians.

3 For the shelter of Pharao will become shame for you, and reproach for those trusting in Egypt.

4 Because in Tanis there are leaders, evil messengers; in vain they will labor

5 toward a people which will not benefit them, neither for help nor for benefit, but for shame and reproach.

6 The vision of the four-footed animals in the desert. In affliction and confinement, a lion and a lion's cub from there, and asps and offspring of flying asps, who carried their wealth upon donkeys and camels toward a nation which will not benefit them for help, but for shame and reproach.

7 Egyptians will benefit you with vain and empty things; announce to them that, This encouragement of yours is vain.

8 Now therefore, sitting, write these things on a tablet and in a book, because these things will be for days of times and forever.

9 Because it is a disobedient people, false sons, who did not desire to hear the law of God,

10 those saying to the prophets, Do not announce to us, and to those seeing the visions, Do not speak to us, but speak to us and announce to us another wandering,

11 and turn us away from this way; take this path away from us and take the Holy One of Israel away from us.

12 Therefore thus says the Lord, the Holy One of Israel, Because you disobeyed these words and hoped in falsehood and because you grumbled and became trusting in this word,

13 therefore this sin will be for you like a wall falling immediately, of a strong city captured, whose fall is immediately present,

14 and her fall will be like the shattering of an earthen vessel, small pieces from a jar, so as not to find among them a shard in which you will lift fire and in which you will draw a little water.

15 Thus says the Lord, the Holy One of Israel, When you turn back and groan, then you will be saved and know where you were; when you had trusted in vain things, your strength became vain. And you did not desire to hear,

16 but said, We will flee upon horses; therefore you will flee; and you said, Upon swift ones we will be riders; therefore those pursuing you will be swift.

17 Because of the voice of one, a thousand will flee, and because of the voice of five, many will flee, until you are left like a mast on a mountain and like one bearing a banner on a hill.

18 And again God will wait to pity you, and therefore he will be exalted to have mercy on you, because the Lord our God is a judge, and where will you leave your glory? Blessed are those abiding in him.

19 Because a holy people will dwell in Sion, and Ierusalem wept with weeping, Have mercy on me; he will have mercy on you at the voice of your cry; when he saw, he listened to you.

20 And the Lord will give you bread of affliction and scant water, and those leading you astray will certainly no longer draw near you, because your eyes will see those leading you astray,

21 and your ears will hear the words of those who led you astray from behind, those saying, This is the way; let us go in it, whether right or left.

22 And you will remove the silver-covered and gold-covered idols; you will make them small and winnow them like the fluid of a menstruating woman and push them away like dung.

23 Then there will be rain for the seed of your land, and the bread of the produce of your land will be abundant and rich; and your livestock will graze on that day in a fertile and spacious place;

24 your bulls and the oxen working the earth will eat straw prepared with barley, winnowed.

25 And there will be water passing through upon every high mountain and upon every lofty hill on that day, when many perish and when towers fall.

26 And the light of the moon will be like the light of the sun, and the light of the sun will be sevenfold on the day when the Lord heals the destruction of his people, and he will heal the pain of your wound.

27 Behold, the name of the Lord comes after a long time, the fury burning, the utterance of his lips with glory, the utterance full of wrath, and the wrath of fury will eat like fire.

28 And his spirit will come like water dragging in a ravine, as far as the neck, and will be divided to trouble nations in vain wandering, and wandering will pursue them and seize them before their face.

29 Must you not continually be glad and enter my holy places continually as though celebrating a festival and as though rejoicing to enter with a pipe into the mountain of the Lord toward the God of Israel?

30 And God will make the glory of his voice audible and show the fury of his arm with fury and wrath and a devouring flame; he will thunder violently, and like water and hail borne down together violently.

31 For because of the voice of the Lord the Assyrians will be defeated by the blow with which he strikes them.

32 And it will be around him, from where his hope of help was, in which he himself had trusted; they themselves with pipes and lyre will war against him in a reversal.

33 For you will be called to account before days; was it not also prepared for you to reign over a deep ravine, wood lying there, fire and much wood? The fury of the Lord is like a ravine burning with sulfur.

Chapter 31

1 Woe to those going down into Egypt for help, those trusting in horses and in chariots, for they are many, and in horses, a very great multitude, and they had not been trusting in the Holy One of Israel and did not seek God.

2 And he himself, wise, brought evils upon them, and his word will certainly not be set aside, and he will rise against houses of evil humans and against their vain hope,

3 an Egyptian human and not a god, horses' flesh, and there is no help; but the Lord will bring his hand upon them, and those helping will grow weary, and all together will perish.

4 Because thus the Lord said to me, In the manner that a lion or a cub cries out over the prey which it took and cries over it until the mountains are filled with its voice, and they were defeated and frightened by the abundance of fury, thus the Lord Sabaoth will go down to campaign against Mount Sion, against her mountains.

5 Like flying birds, thus the Lord will shield Ierusalem and deliver and preserve and save.

6 Turn back, those counseling the deep and lawless counsel.

7 Because on that day humans will renounce their silver and gold handmade things which their hands made.

8 And Assour will fall; no sword of a man or sword of a human will devour him, and he will flee, not before a sword; and the young men will become a defeat,

9 for they will be enclosed by a rock as by a palisade and be defeated, and the one fleeing will be captured. Thus says the Lord, Blessed is the one who has seed in Sion and household members in Ierusalem.

Chapter 32

1 For behold, a righteous king will reign, and rulers will rule with judgment.

2 And the human will be hiding his words and will be hidden as from rushing water; and he will appear in Sion like a rushing river, glorious in a thirsty land.

3 And they will no longer be trusting in humans, but will give their ears to hear.

4 And the heart of the weak will pay attention to hearing, and stammering tongues will quickly learn to speak peace.

5 And they will certainly no longer tell the fool to rule, and your attendants will certainly no longer say, Be silent.

6 For the fool will speak foolish things, and his heart will think vain things, to accomplish lawless things and speak wandering against the Lord, to scatter hungry souls and make thirsty souls empty.

7 For the counsel of the evil ones will counsel lawless things, to destroy humble ones with unjust words and scatter words of humble ones in judgment.

8 But the pious counseled intelligent things, and this counsel will remain.

9 Rich women, rise and hear my voice; daughters in hope, hear my words.

10 Make remembrance of days of a year in pain with hope; the vintage has been consumed, the sowing has ceased and will certainly no longer come.

11 Be astounded, be grieved, confident women; strip yourselves, become naked, gird your waists with sackcloth,

12 and beat yourselves upon the breasts because of a desirable field and a fruitful vine.

13 The land of my people—thorn and grass will come up, and gladness will be taken away from every house; a rich city,

14 abandoned houses will leave the wealth of a city and desirable houses; and the villages will be caves forever, a gladness of wild donkeys, pastures of shepherds,

15 until a spirit from on high comes upon you. And Chermel will be desolate, and Chermel will be reckoned as a wood.

16 And judgment will rest in the desert, and righteousness will dwell in Karmel;

17 and the works of righteousness will be peace, and righteousness will hold rest, and they will be confident forever;

18 and his people will dwell in a city of peace and dwell confidently, and they will rest with wealth.

19 But if hail goes down, it will not come upon you. And those dwelling in the woods will be confident like those in the plain.

20 Blessed are those sowing beside every water, where an ox and a donkey tread.

Chapter 33

1 Woe to those making you miserable, but no one makes you miserable, and the one rejecting you does not reject; those rejecting will be captured and delivered over and defeated thus, like a moth upon a garment.

2 Lord, have mercy on us, for in you we have trusted; the seed of the disobedient became destruction, but our salvation is in a time of affliction.

3 Because of the voice of your terror, peoples were astounded by your terror, and the nations were scattered.

4 But now your spoils will be gathered, of small and great; in the manner that someone gathers locusts, thus they will mock you.

5 Holy is God who dwells in lofty places; Sion was filled with judgment and righteousness.

6 In law they will be delivered over; our salvation is in treasures; there are wisdom and knowledge and piety toward the Lord; these are treasures of righteousness.

7 Behold indeed, at your fear they themselves will fear; those whom you feared will fear because of you; for messengers will be sent requesting peace, weeping bitterly, pleading for peace.

8 For their ways will be desolated; the fear of the nations has ceased, and the covenant with these is taken away, and you will certainly not reckon them humans.

9 The earth mourned, Lebanon was ashamed, Saron became marshes; Galilaia and Karmel will be manifest.

10 Now I will rise, says the Lord, now I will be glorified, now I will be exalted;

11 now you will see, now you will perceive; the strength of your spirit will be vain; fire will devour you.

12 And nations will be burned up like a thorn thrown in a field and burned up.

13 Those far away will hear what I did; those drawing near will know my strength.

14 The lawless in Sion departed; trembling will seize the impious; who will announce to you that fire burns? Who will announce to you the eternal place?

15 One walking in righteousness, speaking a straight way, hating lawlessness and injustice and shaking his hands free of gifts, making his ears heavy so that he may not hear a judgment of blood, shutting his eyes so that he may not see injustice,

16 this one will dwell in a high cave of a strong rock; bread will be given to him, and his water is faithful.

17 You will see a king with glory, and your eyes will see a land far away.

18 Your soul will meditate on fear; where are the scribes? Where are those counseling? Where is the one counting those being fed,

19 a small and great people? To whom they did not give counsel, nor did he know a deep voice so that a despised people did not hear, and there is no understanding for the one hearing.

20 Behold Sion, the city, our salvation; your eyes will see Ierusalem, a rich city, tents which will certainly not be shaken, nor will the stakes of her tent be moved for eternal time, nor will her ropes be torn apart.

21 Because the name of the Lord is great for you; there will be a place for you, rivers and channels, broad and spacious; you will not go this way, nor will a rowing ship go.

22 For my God is great; the Lord will not pass me by; the Lord is our judge, the Lord our ruler, the Lord our king; this one will save us.

23 Your ropes were torn because it was not strong; your mast inclined; it will not lower the sails; it will not raise a sign until it is delivered to plunder; therefore many lame ones will make plunder.

24 And the people dwelling among them will certainly not say, I am weary; for their sin was forgiven them.

Chapter 34

1 Draw near, nations, and hear, rulers; let the earth and those in her hear, the inhabited world and the people in her.

2 Because the fury of the Lord is against all the nations and wrath against their number, to destroy them and deliver them to slaughter.

3 And their wounded and dead will be thrown out, and their odor will rise, and the mountains will be wetted by their blood.

4 And heaven will be rolled like a book, and all the stars will fall like leaves from a vine and as leaves fall from a fig tree.

5 My sword became drunk in heaven; behold, it will go down upon Idoumaia and upon the people of destruction with judgment.

6 The sword of the Lord was filled with blood; it grew fat with the fat of lambs and with the fat of male goats and rams, because there is a sacrifice to the Lord in Bosor and a great slaughter in Idoumaia.

7 And the stout ones will fall together with them, and the rams and bulls, and the earth will become drunk with blood and be filled with their fat.

8 For it is a day of the Lord's judgment and a year of recompense for the judgment of Sion.

9 And her ravines will be turned into pitch and her land into sulfur, and her land will be burning like pitch

10 night and day and will not be extinguished for eternal time, and her smoke will rise upward; for generations and for a long time she will be desolated.

11 And birds and hedgehogs and ibises and ravens will dwell in her, and a measuring cord of desolation will be laid upon her, and donkey-centaurs will dwell in her.

12 Her rulers will not be; for her kings and her rulers and her magnates will be for destruction.

13 And thorny trees will sprout into their cities and into her strongholds, and she will be a dwelling of sirens and a court of ostriches.

14 And demons will meet donkey-centaurs and cry out to one another; there donkey-centaurs will rest, for they found rest for themselves.

15 There a hedgehog nested, and the earth saved her children with security; there deer met and saw one another's faces;

16 they passed by number, and not one of them perished; one did not seek another; because the Lord commanded them, and his spirit gathered them.

17 And he himself will cast lots for them, and his hand divided for grazing; for eternal time you will inherit; for generations of generations they will rest upon her.

Chapter 35

1 Be glad, thirsty desert; let a desert exult and flower like a lily,

2 and the deserted places of the Iordan will blossom and exult; and the glory of Lebanon was given to her and the honor of Karmel, and my people will see the glory of the Lord and the height of God.

3 Grow strong, slack hands and paralyzed knees;

4 give encouragement, those fainthearted in mind; grow strong, do not fear; behold, our God repays judgment and will repay; he himself will come and save us.

5 Then eyes of blind ones will be opened, and ears of deaf ones will hear.

6 Then the lame one will leap like a deer, and the tongue of those speaking with difficulty will be clear, because water burst forth in the desert and a ravine in a thirsty land,

7 and the waterless land will become marshes, and there will be a spring of water in the thirsty land; there will be gladness of birds, a dwelling of reed and marshes.

8 There will be a clean way there, and it will be called a holy way, and an unclean one will certainly not pass there, nor will there be an unclean way there; but the scattered ones will go upon it and certainly not wander.

9 And there will be no lion there, nor will any of the evil beasts go up upon it or be found there, but redeemed ones will go in it.

10 And those gathered because of the Lord will turn back and come into Sion with gladness, and eternal gladness above their head; for upon their head are praise and exultation, and gladness will seize them; pain and grief and groaning fled away.

Chapter 36

1 And it happened in the fourteenth year of Ezekias reigning, Sennacherim king of the Assyrians went up against the strong cities of Ioudaia and took them.

2 And the king of the Assyrians sent Rapsakes from Lachis into Ierusalem to King Ezekias with much force, and he stood at the aqueduct of the upper pool on the road of the fuller's field.

3 And Eliakim the son of Chelkias, the steward, and Somnas the scribe and Ioach the son of Asaph, the recorder, went out to him.

4 And Rapsakes said to them, Say to Ezekias, Thus says the king, the great king of the Assyrians, In what are you trusting?

5 Does a battle formation come to be by counsel or words of lips? And now in whom have you trusted, that you disobey me?

6 Behold, you are trusting in this broken reed rod, in Egypt; whoever leans upon it, it will enter his hand; thus are Pharao king of Egypt and all those trusting in him.

7 But if you say, In the Lord our God we have trusted,

8 now make an agreement with my master, the king of the Assyrians, and I will give you two thousand horses, if you will be able to provide riders upon them.

9 And how can you turn against the face of one district ruler? Those trusting in Egyptians for horse and rider are servants.

10 And now, did we go up against this country to war against her without the Lord?

11 And Eliakim and Somnas and Ioach said to him, Speak to your servants in Syrian, for we understand, and do not speak to us in Ioudaian; and why do you speak into the ears of the humans upon the wall?

12 And Rapsakes said to them, Has my master sent me to your master or to you to speak these words? Not to the humans sitting upon the wall, so that they may eat dung and drink urine together with you?

13 And Rapsakes stood and cried out with a great voice in Ioudaian and said, Hear the words of the king, the great king of the Assyrians:

14 Thus says the king, Do not let Ezekias deceive you with words which will not be able to rescue you;

15 and do not let Ezekias say to you that, God will rescue you, and this city will certainly not be delivered into the hand of the king of the Assyrians;

16 do not listen to Ezekias. Thus says the king of the Assyrians, If you desire to be blessed, come out to me, and each will eat his vine and the fig trees and drink water of your cistern,

17 until I come and take you into a land like your land, a land of grain and wine and bread and vineyards.

18 Do not let Ezekias deceive you, saying, Your God will rescue you. Did the gods of the nations rescue, each, his own country from the hand of the king of the Assyrians?

19 Where is the god of Aimath and Arphath? And where the god of the city Seppharim? Were they able to rescue Samaria from my hand?

20 Who among the gods of all these nations rescued his land from my hand, that God will rescue Ierusalem from my hand?

21 And they were silent, and no one answered him a word, because the king ordered no one to answer.

22 And Eliakim the son of Chelkias, the steward, and Somnas the scribe of the force and Ioach the son of Asaph, the recorder, entered to Ezekias with their tunics torn and announced to him the words of Rapsakes.

Chapter 37

1 And it happened, when King Ezekias heard, he tore his garments and put on sackcloth and went up into the house of the Lord.

2 And he sent Eliakim the steward and Somnas the scribe and the elders of the priests, clothed in sackcloth, to Esaias son of Amos, the prophet,

3 and they said to him, Thus says Ezekias, Today is a day of affliction and reproach and rebuke and wrath, because the pang has come to the woman giving birth, but she has no strength to give birth.

4 May the Lord your God hear the words of Rapsakes, whom the king of the Assyrians sent to reproach a living God and to reproach words which the Lord your God heard; and you will make supplication to the Lord your God concerning these who are left.

5 And the servants of the king came to Esaias,

6 and Esaias said to them, Thus you will say to your master, Thus says the Lord, Do not fear because of the words which you heard, with which the envoys of the king of the Assyrians reproached me;

7 behold, I will cast a spirit into him, and hearing a message he will turn back to his country and fall by a sword in his land.

8 And Rapsakes returned and found the king besieging Lomna. And the king of the Assyrians heard that

9 Tharaka king of the Ethiopians went out to besiege him; and hearing, he turned back and sent messengers to Ezekias, saying,

10 Thus you will say to Ezekias king of Ioudaia, Do not let your God in whom you are trusting deceive you, saying, Ierusalem will certainly not be delivered into the hands of the king of the Assyrians.

11 Or did you not hear what the kings of the Assyrians did, how they destroyed all the earth?

12 Did the gods of the nations whom my fathers destroyed rescue them, both Gozan and Charran and Raphes, which are in the country of Themad?

13 Where are the kings of Aimath and Arphath and of the city Seppharim, Anag, Ougaua? —

14 And Ezekias took the document from the messengers and opened it before the Lord,

15 and Ezekias prayed to the Lord, saying,

16 Lord Sabaoth, the God of Israel, who sits upon the cheroubin, you alone are God of every kingdom of the inhabited world; you made heaven and earth.

17 Hear, Lord; look, Lord, and see the words which Sennacherim sent to reproach a living God.

18 For in truth the kings of the Assyrians desolated the whole inhabited world and their country

19 and cast their idols into the fire, for they were not gods but works of human hands, wood and stones, and they destroyed them.

20 But you, Lord our God, save us from their hand, so that every kingdom of the earth may know that you alone are God.

21 And Esaias son of Amos was sent to Ezekias and said to him, Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel, I heard what you prayed to me concerning Sennacherim king of the Assyrians.

22 This is the word which God spoke concerning him: A virgin daughter of Sion despised you and sneered at you; a daughter of Ierusalem shook a head at you.

23 Whom did you reproach and provoke? Or against whom did you lift your voice? And you did not lift your eyes on high toward the Holy One of Israel.

24 Because through messengers you reproached the Lord; for you said, With the multitude of chariots I went up to the height of mountains and into the furthest parts of Lebanon and cut the height of its cedar and the beauty of the cypress and entered the height of a part of the wood

25 and set a bridge and desolated waters and every gathering of water.

26 Did you not hear long ago these things which I did? From ancient days I ordered them, but now I showed the desolating of nations in strongholds and those dwelling in strong cities;

27 I relaxed the hands, and they dried up and became like dry grass upon roofs and like wild grass.

28 But now I know your rest and your going out and your coming in;

29 and your fury with which you were angered and your bitterness rose to me, and I will cast a muzzle into your nose and a bridle into your lips and turn you back by the way in which you came.

30 And this is the sign for you: eat this year what you have sown, and in the second year the remnant, and in the third, sowing, reap and plant vineyards and eat their fruit.

31 And it shall be that those left in Ioudaia will grow a root below and make seed above.

32 Because those left will come out of Ierusalem, and those being saved out of Mount Sion; the zeal of the Lord Sabaoth will do these things.

33 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning the king of the Assyrians, He will certainly not enter this city or cast an arrow upon her or lay a shield upon her or encircle her with a palisade,

34 but by the way in which he came, by it he will turn back; thus says the Lord.

35 I will shield this city to save her because of me and because of David my servant.

36 And an angel of the Lord went out and killed one hundred eighty-five thousand from the encampment of the Assyrians, and rising in the morning, they found all the bodies dead.

37 And turning back, the king of the Assyrians departed and dwelt in Nineue.

38 And while he was worshiping his patachron in the house of Nasarach, Adramelech and Sarasar his sons struck him with swords, and they themselves escaped into Armenia; and Asordan his son reigned in his place.

Chapter 38

1 And it happened at that time that Ezekias became sick unto death; and Esaias son of Amos, the prophet, came to him and said to him, Thus says the Lord, Put your house in order, for you are dying and will not live.

2 And Ezekias turned his face toward the wall and prayed to the Lord,

3 saying, Remember, Lord, how I walked before you with truth in a true heart and did the pleasing things before you; and Ezekias wept with great weeping.

4 And a word of the Lord came to Esaias, saying,

5 Go and say to Ezekias, Thus says the Lord, the God of David your father, I heard the voice of your prayer and saw your tears; behold, I add fifteen years to your time;

6 and I will save you from the hand of the king of the Assyrians and shield this city.

7 And this is the sign for you from the Lord, that God will do this utterance;

8 the shadow of the steps which the sun went down, the ten steps of your father's house—I will turn the sun back the ten steps. And the sun went up the ten steps which the shadow went down.

9 A prayer of Ezekias king of Ioudaia, when he became sick and rose from his sickness.

10 I said, At the height of my days, at the gates of Hades, I will leave the remaining years.

11 I said, I will certainly no longer see the salvation of God upon the earth; I will certainly no longer see a human

12 from my kinship. I left the remainder of my life; it went out and departed from me like one dismantling a tent which he pitched; my spirit with me became like the web of a weaving woman drawing near to cut it off. On that day I was delivered over

13 until morning as to a lion; thus he shattered my bones, for from day until night I was delivered over.

14 Like a swallow, thus I will sound, and like a dove, thus I will murmur; for my eyes failed from looking toward the height of heaven, toward the Lord, who delivered me

15 and took away the pain of my soul.

16 Lord, for concerning her it was announced to you, and you roused my breath, and, comforted, I lived.

17 For you chose my soul so that it may not perish, and you cast all my sins behind me.

18 For those in Hades will not praise you, nor will those dead bless you, nor will those in Hades hope for your mercy;

19 the living will bless you in the manner that I too do. For from today I will make children who will announce your righteousness,

20 Lord of my salvation; and I will not cease blessing you with a harp all the days of my life before the house of God.

21 And Esaias said to Ezekias, Take a cake of figs and crush it and apply it as a poultice, and you will be healthy.

22 And Ezekias said, This is the sign, that I will go up into the house of the Lord God.

Chapter 39

1 At that time Marodach son of Laadan, the king of Babylonia, sent letters and envoys and gifts to Ezekias; for he heard that he became sick unto death and rose.

2 And Ezekias rejoiced over them with great joy and showed them the house of the nechotha and of the stacte and of the incenses and of the ointment and of the silver and of the gold, and all the houses of the equipment of the treasury and everything which was in his treasures; and there was nothing which Ezekias did not show in his house.

3 And Esaias the prophet came to King Ezekias and said to him, What do these humans say, and from where have they come to you? And Ezekias said, From a land far away they have come to me, from Babylon.

4 And Esaias said, What did they see in your house? And Ezekias said, They saw everything in my house, and there is nothing in my house which they did not see, but also the things in my treasures.

5 And Esaias said to him, Hear the word of the Lord Sabaoth:

6 Behold, days come, says the Lord, and they will take everything in your house, and whatever your fathers gathered until this day will come to Babylon, and they will certainly leave nothing; and God said

7 that they will also take from your children whom you begot and make them eunuchs in the house of the king of the Babylonians.

8 And Ezekias said to Esaias, Good is the word of the Lord which he spoke; let there indeed be peace and righteousness in my days.

Chapter 40

1 Comfort, comfort my people, says God.

2 Priests, speak into the heart of Ierusalem; comfort her, because her humiliation was fulfilled, her sin has been loosed, because she received from the hand of the Lord her sins double.

3 A voice of one crying in the desert, Prepare the way of the Lord; make straight the paths of our God;

4 every ravine will be filled, and every mountain and hill will be humbled, and all the crooked things will become straight, and the rough way plains;

5 and the glory of the Lord will be seen, and all flesh will see the salvation of God, because the Lord spoke.

6 A voice of one saying, Cry out; and I said, What shall I cry? All flesh is grass, and all human glory like a flower of grass;

7 the grass dried up, and the flower fell,

8 but the utterance of our God remains forever.

9 Go up upon a high mountain, the one announcing good news to Sion; lift your voice with strength, the one announcing good news to Ierusalem; lift it, do not fear; say to the cities of Iouda, Behold, your God.

10 Behold, the Lord comes with strength, and the arm with dominion; behold, his wage is with him and the work before him.

11 Like a shepherd he will shepherd his flock and gather lambs with his arm and comfort those having in the womb.

12 Who measured the water with the hand and heaven with a span and all the earth with a handful? Who weighed the mountains with a weight and the valleys with a balance?

13 Who knew the mind of the Lord, and who became his counselor, who instructs him?

14 Or with whom did he take counsel, and who instructed him? Or who showed him judgment? Or who showed him a way of understanding?

15 If all the nations were reckoned like a drop from a bucket and like a tilt of a balance, they will also be reckoned like saliva;

16 and Lebanon is not sufficient for burning, and all the four-footed animals are not sufficient for a whole burnt offering,

17 and all the nations are like nothing and were reckoned as nothing.

18 To whom did you liken the Lord, and to what likeness did you liken him?

19 Did a craftsman make an image, or did a goldsmith, melting gold, gild him, fashion him as a likeness?

20 For a craftsman chooses wood that does not rot and wisely seeks how he will set up his image, and so that it may not be shaken.

21 Will you not know? Will you not hear? Was it not announced to you from the beginning? Did you not know the foundations of the earth?

22 The one holding the circle of the earth, and those dwelling in her are like locusts, the one setting heaven like a vault and stretching it like a tent to dwell in,

23 the one giving rulers nothing to rule, and he made the earth like nothing.

24 For they will certainly not sow or plant, nor will their root be rooted into the earth; he blew upon them, and they dried up, and a tempest will take them up like brushwood.

25 Now therefore, to whom did you liken me, and I will be exalted? said the Holy One.

26 Look up on high with your eyes and see; who showed all these things? The one bringing forth his adornment by number will call all by name; because of much glory and in the might of strength, nothing escaped you.

27 For do not say, Iakob—and what did you speak, Israel?—My way was hidden from God, and my God took away the judgment and departed?

28 And now, did you not know, if you did not hear? An eternal God is the God who fashioned the ends of the earth; he will not hunger or grow weary, nor is there a searching out of his understanding;

29 giving strength to the hungry and grief to those not suffering pain.

30 For younger ones will hunger, and young men will grow weary, and chosen ones will be powerless;

31 but those waiting for God will exchange strength; they will grow wings like eagles; they will run and not grow weary; they will walk and not hunger.

Chapter 41

1 Be renewed toward me, islands, for the rulers will exchange strength; let them draw near and speak together; then let them announce judgment.

2 Who raised righteousness from the east, called her to his feet, and she will go? He will give her before nations and astound kings and put their swords into the earth and their bows like driven-out brushwood;

3 and he will pursue them, and the way of his feet will pass through in peace.

4 Who worked and did these things? The one calling her from generations of the beginning called her; I am God, first, and for the things coming I am.

5 Nations saw and feared; the ends of the earth drew near and came together,

6 each judging to help the neighbor and the brother, and he will say,

7 A man, a craftsman, grew strong, and a smith striking with a hammer, beating together; at one time he will say, The joint is good; they strengthened them with nails; they will set them, and they will not be moved.

8 But you, Israel, my servant Iakob whom I chose, seed of Abraam whom I loved,

9 of whom I took hold from the ends of the earth, and from her lookouts I called you and said to you, You are my servant; I chose you and did not abandon you,

10 do not fear, for I am with you; do not wander, for I am your God who strengthened you, and I helped you and secured you with my righteous right hand.

11 Behold, all those opposing you will be ashamed and abashed; for they will be as though not existing, and all your adversaries will perish.

12 You will seek them and certainly not find the humans who will act insolently toward you; for they will be as though not existing, and those warring against you will not be.

13 Because I am your God, the one holding your right hand, the one saying to you, Do not fear,

14 Iakob, very small Israel; I helped you, says God who redeems you, Israel.

15 Behold, I made you like new, saw-shaped threshing wheels of a wagon, and you will thresh mountains and make hills small and turn them into chaff;

16 and you will winnow, and wind will take them, and a tempest will scatter them, but you will be glad in the holy ones of Israel. And they will exult,

17 the poor and the needy; for they will seek water, and there will be none; their tongue dried up from thirst; I am the Lord God; I will listen, the God of Israel, and will not abandon them,

18 but will open rivers upon the mountains and springs in the midst of plains, make the desert into marshes and the thirsty land into aqueducts;

19 I will put cedar and box and myrtle and cypress and poplar into the waterless land,

20 so that they may see and know and consider and understand together that the hand of the Lord did all these things, and the Holy One of Israel showed them.

21 Your judgment draws near, says the Lord God; your counsels drew near, says the king of Iakob.

22 Let them draw near and announce to you what will happen, or say what the former things were, and we will apply the mind and know what the last things are, and tell us the things coming.

23 Announce to us the things coming at the end, and we will know that you are gods; do good and do harm, and we will marvel and see together;

24 because from where are you, and from where is your work? From earth; they chose you, an abomination.

25 But I raised the one from the north and the one from the rising of the sun; they will be called by my name; let rulers come, and like potter's clay and like a potter treading clay, thus you will be trampled.

26 For who will announce the things from the beginning, so that we may know, and the things beforehand, and we will say that they are true? There is no one foretelling or hearing your words.

27 I will give a beginning to Sion and encourage Ierusalem for a way.

28 For from the nations, behold, no one, and from their idols there was no one announcing; and if I ask them, From where are you? they will certainly not answer me.

29 For those making you exist, and those leading you astray do so in vain.

Chapter 42

1 Iakob is my servant; I will uphold him; Israel is my chosen one; my soul accepted him; I gave my spirit upon him; he will bring forth judgment to the nations.

2 He will not cry out or raise his voice, nor will his voice be heard outside.

3 He will not shatter a broken reed or extinguish smoking flax, but he will bring forth judgment in truth.

4 He will shine forth and not be crushed until he sets judgment upon the earth; and nations will hope in his name.

5 Thus says the Lord God who made heaven and pitched it, who established the earth and the things in her, and gives breath to the people upon her and spirit to those treading her;

6 I, the Lord God, called you in righteousness and will hold your hand and strengthen you, and I gave you for a covenant of a race, for a light of nations,

7 to open eyes of blind ones, to bring bound ones out of bonds and those sitting in darkness out of a prison house. —

8 I am the Lord God; this is my name; I will not give my glory to another or my excellences to carved things.

9 Behold, the things from the beginning have come, and new things which I will announce, and before springing up they were made clear to you.

10 Hymn a new hymn to the Lord, his dominion; glorify his name from the end of the earth, those going down into the sea and sailing it, the islands and those dwelling in them.

11 Be glad, desert and her villages, dwellings and those dwelling in Kedar; those dwelling in Petra will be glad; from the tops of the mountains they will cry out;

12 they will give glory to God; they will announce his excellences in the islands.

13 The Lord, the God of forces, will go out and shatter war; he will rouse zeal and cry out against his enemies with strength.

14 I was silent; will I also always be silent and endure? I persevered like a woman giving birth; I will astound and dry up together.

15 And I will make rivers into islands and dry up marshes.

16 And I will lead blind ones in a way which they did not know and make them tread paths which they did not know; I will make darkness into light for them and crooked things into straight; I will do these utterances and will not abandon them.

17 But they themselves turned backward; be ashamed with shame, those trusting in carved things, those saying to cast things, You are our gods.

18 Deaf ones, hear, and blind ones, look up to see.

19 And who is blind but my servants, and deaf but those ruling them? And the slaves of God were blinded.

20 You saw many times and did not guard yourselves; the ears are open, and you did not hear.

21 The Lord God desired that he be justified and magnify praise. And I saw,

22 and the people became plundered and pillaged; for the snare is in the chambers everywhere, and together in houses where they hid them; they became plunder, and there was no one delivering what was seized, and there was no one saying, Give it back.

23 Who among you will give ear to these things, will listen for the things coming?

24 Who gave Iakob to pillaging and Israel to those plundering him? Was it not God, against whom they sinned and did not desire to go in his ways or hear his law?

25 And he brought upon them the wrath of his fury, and war prevailed against them and those burning them up all around, and each of them did not know or lay it upon the soul.

Chapter 43

1 And now thus says the Lord God who made you, Iakob, who formed you, Israel, Do not fear, because I redeemed you; I called you by your name; you are mine.

2 And if you cross through water, I am with you, and rivers will not overwhelm you; and if you pass through fire, you will certainly not be burned up; a flame will not burn you up.

3 Because I am the Lord your God, the Holy One of Israel who saves you; I made Egypt your exchange, and Ethiopia and Soene for you.

4 Since you became precious before me, you were glorified, and I loved you; and I will give many humans for you and rulers for your head.

5 Do not fear, because I am with you; from the east I will bring your seed and from the west gather you.

6 I will say to the north, Bring, and to the southwest, Do not hinder; bring my sons from a land far away and my daughters from the ends of the earth,

7 all who have been called by my name. For in my glory I fashioned him and formed and made him;

8 and I brought out a blind people, and eyes are likewise blind, and they are deaf, having ears.

9 All the nations were gathered together, and rulers will be gathered from them; who will announce these things? Or who will announce to you the things from the beginning? Let them bring their witnesses and be justified and say true things.

10 Become witnesses for me, and I am a witness, says the Lord God, and the servant whom I chose, so that you may know and believe and understand that I am; before me no other god came to be, and after me there will be none;

11 I am God, and there is no one saving apart from me.

12 I announced and saved, I reproached, and there was no stranger among you; you are witnesses for me, and I am a witness, says the Lord God.

13 Yet from the beginning, and there is no one delivering from my hands; I will do it, and who will turn it back?

14 Thus says the Lord God who redeems you, the Holy One of Israel, For your sake I will send into Babylon and raise up all who flee, and Chaldeans will be bound in ships.

15 I am the Lord God, your Holy One, who showed Israel as your king.

16 Thus says the Lord who gives a way in a sea and a path in strong water,

17 who brought out chariots and horse and a strong crowd, but they fell asleep and will not rise; they were extinguished like extinguished flax:

18 Do not remember the first things, and do not reckon together the ancient things.

19 Behold, I make new things which will now spring up, and you will know them; and I will make a way in the desert and rivers in the waterless land.

20 The beasts of the field will bless me, sirens and daughters of ostriches, because I gave water in the desert and rivers in the waterless land to give drink to my chosen race,

21 my people whom I acquired to recount my excellences.

22 I did not now call you, Iakob, nor did I make you weary, Israel;

23 the sheep of your whole burnt offering were not for me, nor did you glorify me in your sacrifices, nor did I make you labor with frankincense,

24 nor did you acquire incense for me with silver, nor did I desire the fat of your sacrifices, but in your sins and in your injustices I stood before you.

25 I am, I am the one wiping out your lawless deeds, and I will certainly not remember.

26 But you remember, and let us be judged; you say your lawless deeds first, so that you may be justified.

27 Your first fathers and their rulers acted lawlessly against me,

28 and the rulers defiled my holy things, and I gave Iakob to destruction and Israel to reproach.

Chapter 44

1 But now hear, my servant Iakob and Israel whom I chose;

2 thus says the Lord God who made you and who formed you from the womb, You will yet be helped; do not fear, my servant Iakob and beloved Israel whom I chose;

3 because I will give water in thirst to those going in a waterless land; I will put my spirit upon your seed and my blessings upon your children,

4 and they will spring up like grass in the midst of water and like a willow beside flowing water.

5 This one will say, I am God's, and this one will cry out in the name of Iakob, and another will inscribe, I am God's, in the name of Israel.

6 Thus says God, the king of Israel, who rescued him, God Sabaoth, I am first, and I am after these things; apart from me there is no god.

7 Who is like me? Let him stand, call and prepare for me since I made a human forever, and let them announce to you the things coming before they come.

8 Do not cover yourselves; did you not give ear from the beginning, and I announced to you? You are witnesses whether there is a god apart from me; and they were not then.

9 Those forming and carving are all vain, those making the things they desire, which will not benefit them; but they will be ashamed,

10 all those forming a god and carving useless things,

11 and all from whom they came to be dried up, and let deaf ones from among humans all be gathered and stand together, be abashed and ashamed together.

12 Because a craftsman sharpened iron, worked it with an adze and bored it with a drill, worked it with the arm of his strength; and he will hunger and be weak and certainly not drink water. Having chosen

13 wood, a craftsman set it by measure and fitted it with glue; he made it like the form of a man and like the beauty of a human, to set it in a house.

14 The wood which he cut from the wood, which the Lord planted and rain lengthened,

15 so that it may be for humans for burning; and taking from it, he warmed himself, and burning it, they baked bread upon them; but they worked the remainder into gods and worship them.

16 Half of it they burned up in fire and, burning it, baked bread upon them; and roasting meat upon it, he ate and was filled; and, warmed, he said, It is pleasant for me, because I was warmed and saw fire.

17 But the remainder he made into a carved god and worships it and prays, saying, Deliver me, because you are my god.

18 They did not know to understand, because they were dimmed from seeing with their eyes and thinking with their heart.

19 And he did not reckon in his heart or consider in his soul or know in his understanding that he burned half of it in fire and baked bread upon its coals and roasted meat and ate, and made its remainder into an abomination, and they worship it.

20 Know that their heart is ash, and they wander, and no one can deliver his soul; see, will you not say that, Falsehood is in my right hand?

21 Remember these things, Iakob and Israel, because you are my servant; I formed you as my servant, and you, Israel, do not forget me.

22 For behold, I wiped away your lawless deeds like a cloud and your sins like gloom; turn to me, and I will redeem you.

23 Be glad, heavens, because God had mercy on Israel; trumpet, foundations of the earth; cry out gladness, mountains, the hills and all the trees in them, because God redeemed Iakob, and Israel will be glorified.

24 Thus says the Lord who redeems you and who forms you from the womb, I, the Lord who accomplishes everything, stretched heaven alone and established the earth. Who else

25 will scatter signs of ventriloquists and divinations from a heart, turning intelligent ones backward and making their counsel foolish,

26 and establishing utterances of his servant and making the counsel of his messengers true? The one saying to Ierusalem, You will be inhabited, and to the cities of Ioudaia, You will be built, and her deserted places will spring up;

27 the one saying to the abyss, You will be desolated, and I will dry up your rivers;

28 the one telling Kyros to be wise, and, He will do all my desires; the one saying to Ierusalem, You will be built, and I will found my holy house.

Chapter 45

1 Thus says the Lord God to my anointed Kyros, whose right hand I held so that nations may obey before him, and I will tear apart the strength of kings, open doors before him, and cities will not be shut:

2 I will go before you and level mountains; I will shatter bronze doors and break iron bars,

3 and give you dark treasures; I will open hidden, unseen ones to you, so that you may know that I am the Lord God who calls your name, the God of Israel.

4 For the sake of Iakob my servant and Israel my chosen one, I will call you by your name and accept you, but you did not know me.

5 Because I am the Lord God, and there is no god besides me any longer, and you did not know me,

6 so that those from the rising of the sun and those from the west may know that there is none apart from me; I am the Lord God, and there is no other;

7 I am the one who fashioned light and made darkness, who makes peace and creates evils; I am the Lord God who does all these things.

8 Let heaven be glad from above, and let the clouds sprinkle righteousness; let the earth bring forth mercy and bring forth righteousness together; I am the Lord who created you.

9 What better thing did I fashion like potter's clay? Will the one plowing plow the earth all day? Will the clay say to the potter, What are you doing, because you do not work or have hands?

10 The one saying to the father, What will you beget? and to the mother, What will you labor to bear?

11 Because thus says the Lord God, the Holy One of Israel who made the things coming, Ask me concerning my sons and concerning my daughters, and command me concerning the works of my hands.

12 I made earth and a human upon her; I established heaven with my hand; I commanded all the stars.

13 I raised him as king with righteousness, and all his ways are straight; this one will build my city and turn back the captivity of my people, not with ransoms or with gifts, said the Lord Sabaoth.

14 Thus says the Lord Sabaoth, Egypt labored, and trade of Ethiopians, and the Seboin, tall men, will cross over to you and be slaves to you and follow behind you, bound with handcuffs, and worship you and pray in you, because God is in you, and they will say, There is no god apart from you;

15 for you are God, and we did not know, the God of Israel, a Savior.

16 All those opposing him will be ashamed and abashed and go in shame. Be renewed toward me, islands.

17 Israel is saved by the Lord with eternal salvation; they will not be ashamed or abashed forever.

18 Thus says the Lord who made heaven—this is the God who showed the earth and made her; he himself marked her out; he did not make her for emptiness but to be inhabited—I am, and there is no other.

19 I have not spoken in secret or in a dark place of earth; I did not say to the seed of Iakob, Seek a vain thing; I am, I am the Lord speaking righteousness and announcing truth.

20 Be gathered and come; take counsel together, those being saved from the nations. Those lifting the wood, their carving, and praying as to gods who do not save did not know.

21 If they will announce, let them draw near, so that they may know together who made these things audible from the beginning. Then it was announced to you, I am God, and there is no other apart from me; there is no righteous one and Savior besides me.

22 Turn to me, and you will be saved, those from the furthest part of the earth; I am God, and there is no other.

23 By myself I swear, Surely righteousness will come out of my mouth; my words will not turn back, that every knee will bend to me, and every tongue will confess to God,

24 saying, Righteousness and glory will come to him, and all those separating themselves will be ashamed;

25 from the Lord all the seed of the sons of Israel will be justified and glorified in God.

Chapter 46

1 Bel fell, Dagon was shattered, their carved things became for beasts and livestock; lift them, tied up like a burden for one weary

2 and hungry and weakened, without strength, together, who will not be able to be saved from war, but they themselves were led captive.

3 Hear me, house of Iakob and all the remnant of Israel, those lifted from the womb and disciplined from childhood;

4 until old age I am, and until you grow very old, I am; I endure you, I made and I will release, I will take up and save you.

5 To whom did you liken me? See, devise, those wandering.

6 Those contributing gold from a purse will weigh silver with a balance by weight, and hiring a goldsmith, they made handmade things and, bowing, worship them.

7 They lift it upon the shoulders and go; but if they set it down, it remains in its place; it will certainly not be moved; and whoever cries out to it, it will certainly not listen; it will certainly not save him from evils.

8 Remember these things and groan; repent, those led astray; turn back in heart.

9 And remember the former things from eternity, because I am God, and there is no other apart from me,

10 announcing the last things beforehand, before they come to be, and together they were accomplished; and I said, All my counsel will stand, and everything which I have counseled I will do;

11 calling a bird from the east and from a land far away concerning the things which I have counseled, I spoke and brought, I created and did, I brought him and prospered his way.

12 Hear me, those who have lost the heart, those far from righteousness.

13 I brought my righteousness near and will not delay the salvation from me; I have given salvation in Sion to Israel for glory.

Chapter 47

1 Go down, sit upon the earth, virgin daughter of Babylon; enter darkness, daughter of the Chaldeans, because you will no longer continue to be called delicate and tender.

2 Take a mill, grind flour, uncover your veil, uncover the gray hairs, bare the shins, cross rivers;

3 your shame will be uncovered, your reproaches will appear; I will take justice from you; I will certainly no longer deliver it to humans.

4 The one who rescued you said, the Lord Sabaoth is his name, the Holy One of Israel:

5 Sit stricken, enter darkness, daughter of the Chaldeans; you will certainly no longer be called strength of a kingdom.

6 I was provoked against my people; you defiled my inheritance; I gave into your hand, but you did not give them mercy; you made the elder's yoke very heavy.

7 And you said, Forever I will be a ruler; you did not consider these things in your heart or remember the last things.

8 But now hear these things, tender woman sitting confidently, saying in her heart, I am, and there is no other; I will not sit as a widow or know orphanhood.

9 But now these two things will come suddenly upon you in one day; widowhood and childlessness will come suddenly upon you in your sorcery, in the strength of your enchantments, exceedingly,

10 in the hope of your wickedness. For you said, I am, and there is no other. Know that the understanding of these things and your prostitution will be shame for you. And you said in your heart, I am, and there is no other.

11 And destruction will come upon you, and you will certainly not know, a pit, and you will fall into it; and misery will come upon you, and you will certainly not be able to become clean; and destruction will come upon you suddenly, and you will certainly not know.

12 Stand now in your enchantments and your abundant sorcery, which you learned from your youth, if you will be able to be benefited.

13 You have grown weary in your counsels; let the astrologers of heaven stand and save you; let those seeing the stars announce to you what is going to come upon you.

14 Behold, all will be burned up like brushwood upon fire and will certainly not deliver their soul from a flame; because you have coals of fire, sit upon them.

15 These will be a help to you; you labored in your trade from youth; each human wandered by himself, but there will be no salvation for you.

Chapter 48

1 Hear these things, house of Iakob, those called by the name of Israel and those who came out of Iouda, those swearing by the name of the Lord God of Israel, remembering not with truth or with righteousness,

2 and clinging to the name of the holy city and leaning upon the God of Israel; the Lord Sabaoth is his name.

3 I announced the former things beforehand, and they came out of my mouth and became audible; suddenly I did them, and they came upon you.

4 I know that you are harsh, and your neck is an iron sinew, and your forehead bronze.

5 And I announced to you long ago; before it came upon you I made it audible to you; do not say that, My idols did it, and do not say that, The carved things and the cast things commanded me.

6 You heard everything, and you did not know; but I also made audible to you the new things from now, which are going to happen, and you did not speak.

7 Now they happen and not long ago, and you did not hear them in former days; do not say that, Yes, I know them.

8 You neither knew nor understood, nor did I open your ears from the beginning; for I knew that, rejecting, you will reject, and, lawless still from the womb, you will be beguiled.

9 For the sake of my name I will show you my fury and bring my glorious things upon you, so that I may not destroy you.

10 Behold, I have sold you, not for the sake of silver, but I delivered you from a furnace of poverty;

11 for my sake I will do it for you, because my name is profaned, and I will not give my glory to another.

12 Hear me, Iakob and Israel whom I call; I am first, and I am forever,

13 and my hand founded the earth, and my right hand established heaven; I will call them, and they will stand together

14 and all be gathered and hear. Who announced these things to them? Loving you, I did your desire against Babylon, to take away the seed of the Chaldeans.

15 I spoke, I called, I brought him and prospered his way.

16 Draw near to me and hear these things; from the beginning I did not speak in secret or in a dark place of earth; when it happened, I was there, and now the Lord has sent me, and his spirit.

17 Thus says the Lord who rescued you, the Holy One of Israel, I am your God; I have shown you so that you may find the way in which you will go.

18 And if you had heard my commands, your peace would have become like a river and your righteousness like a wave of the sea;

19 and your seed would have become like the sand and the offspring of your womb like the dust of the earth; nor will you even now be destroyed, nor will your name perish before me.

20 Come out of Babylon, fleeing from the Chaldeans; announce a voice of gladness, and let this become audible; announce as far as the furthest part of the earth; say, The Lord rescued his slave Iakob.

21 And if they thirst, he will lead them through a desert; he will bring out water from a rock for them; a rock will be split, and water will flow, and my people will drink.

22 There is no rejoicing for the impious, says the Lord.

Chapter 49

1 Hear me, islands, and pay attention, nations; after a long time it will stand, says the Lord. From my mother's womb he called my name

2 and made my mouth like a sharp sword, and under the shelter of his hand he hid me; he made me like a chosen arrow and sheltered me in his quiver.

3 And he said to me, You are my slave, Israel, and in you I will be glorified.

4 And I said, I labored emptily and gave my strength to vanity and nothing; therefore my judgment is with the Lord, and my toil before my God.

5 And now thus says the Lord who formed me from the womb as a slave for himself, to gather Iakob and Israel to him—I will be gathered and glorified before the Lord, and my God will be my strength—

6 and he said to me, It is great for you to be called my servant, to establish the tribes of Iakob and turn back the dispersion of Israel; behold, I have made you a covenant of a race, a light of nations, so that you may be salvation as far as the furthest part of the earth.

7 Thus says the Lord who rescued you, the God of Israel, Sanctify the one despising his soul, the one abhorred by the nations of the slaves of the rulers; kings will see him and rise, and rulers will worship him for the sake of the Lord; because the Holy One of Israel is faithful, and I chose you.

8 Thus says the Lord, At an acceptable time I listened to you, and on a day of salvation I helped you and gave you for a covenant of nations, to establish the earth and inherit an inheritance of a desert,

9 saying to those in bonds, Come out, and to those in darkness to be uncovered. And on all their ways they will graze, and on all the paths will be their pasture;

10 they will not hunger or thirst, nor will scorching heat or the sun strike them, but the one having mercy on them will comfort and lead them through springs of waters;

11 and I will make every mountain a way and every path a pasture for them.

12 Behold, these come from far away, these from the north and these from the sea, and others from the land of the Persians.

13 Be glad, heavens, and let the earth exult; let the mountains burst forth gladness and the hills righteousness, because God had mercy on his people and comforted the humble of his people.

14 But Sion said, The Lord abandoned me, and the Lord forgot me.

15 Will a woman forget her child, so as not to have mercy on the offspring of her womb? But even if a woman should forget these, I will not forget you, said the Lord.

16 Behold, upon my hands I painted your walls, and you are before me continually;

17 and quickly you will be built by those by whom you were pulled down, and those desolating you will come out of you.

18 Lift your eyes around and see all; behold, they were gathered and came to you; I live, says the Lord, that you will put on all of them and put them around you like a bride's adornment.

19 Because your deserted places and the destroyed and fallen things will now be cramped because of those dwelling, and those swallowing you will be far removed from you.

20 For your sons whom you lost will say into your ears, The place is narrow for me; make a place for me so that I may dwell.

21 And you will say in your heart, Who begot these for me? But I am childless and a widow, and who reared these for me? But I was left alone, and where were these for me?

22 Thus says the Lord, Behold, I lift my hand to the nations and will raise my signal to the islands, and they will bring your sons in a bosom and lift your daughters upon shoulders,

23 and kings will be your fosterers and ruling women your nurses; upon the face of the earth they will worship you and lick the dust of your feet; and you will know that I am the Lord, and you will not be ashamed.

24 Will someone take spoils from a giant? And if someone takes captive unjustly, will he be saved?

25 Thus says the Lord, If someone takes a giant captive, he will take spoils; and taking from a strong one, he will be saved; but I will judge your judgment, and I will rescue your sons;

26 and those who afflicted you will eat their flesh and drink their blood like new wine and become drunk, and all flesh will perceive that I am the Lord who rescued you and who upholds the strength of Iakob.

Chapter 50

1 Thus says the Lord, What is the document of your mother's divorce, by which I sent her away? Or to what creditor have I sold you? Behold, for your sins you were sold, and for your lawless deeds I sent your mother away.

2 Why was it that I came and there was no human? I called and there was no one obeying? Does my hand lack strength to rescue? Or do I lack strength to deliver? Behold, by my threat I will desolate the sea and make rivers desolate, and their fish will dry up because there is no water and die in thirst.

3 And I will clothe heaven with darkness and make its covering like sackcloth.

4 The Lord gives me a tongue of discipline, to know at a time when it is necessary to say a word; he appointed morning for me; he added an ear for me to hear;

5 and the discipline of the Lord opens my ears, but I do not disobey or contradict.

6 I have given my back to scourges and my cheeks to blows, and I did not turn my face away from the shame of spittings;

7 and the Lord became my helper; therefore I was not abashed, but I made my face like solid rock and knew that I would certainly not be ashamed.

8 Because the one who justified me draws near; who is the one contending with me? Let him stand against me together; and who is the one contending with me? Let him draw near me.

9 Behold, the Lord helps me; who will harm me? Behold, all of you will grow old like a garment, and as a moth he will devour you.

10 Who among you is the one fearing the Lord? Let him hear the voice of his servant; those going in darkness have no light; trust in the name of the Lord and lean upon God.

11 Behold, all of you kindle fire and strengthen a flame; go by the light of your fire and by the flame which you kindled; because of me these things happened to you; in grief you will sleep.

Chapter 51

1 Hear me, those pursuing justice and seeking the Lord; look toward the solid rock which you hewed and toward the pit of the cistern which you dug.

2 Look toward Abraam your father and toward Sarra who labored to bear you, because he was one, and I called him and blessed him and loved him and multiplied him.

3 And you I will now comfort, Sion, and I comforted all her deserted places and will make her deserted places like a paradise of the Lord; they will find gladness and exultation in her, thanksgiving and a voice of praise. —

4 Hear me, hear, my people, and kings, give ear to me, because a law will come forth from me, and my judgment as a light of nations.

5 My righteousness draws near quickly, and my salvation will come forth like light, and nations will hope in my arm; islands will wait for me and hope in my arm.

6 Lift your eyes toward heaven and look toward the earth below, because heaven was established like smoke, and the earth will grow old like a garment, and those dwelling on the earth will die like these, but my salvation will be forever, and my righteousness will certainly not fail. —

7 Hear me, those knowing judgment, my people, whose heart contains my law; do not fear the reproach of humans and do not be defeated by their contempt.

8 For like a garment it will be eaten by time and like wool eaten by a moth; but my righteousness will be forever, and my salvation for generations of generations.

9 Awake, awake, Ierusalem, and put on the strength of your arm; awake as at the beginning of a day, as a generation of eternity. Are you not

10 the one desolating a sea, the abundant water of an abyss? The one making the depths of the sea a way of crossing for those being rescued

11 and redeemed? For by the Lord they will turn back and come into Sion with gladness and eternal exultation; for upon their head are exultation and praise, and gladness will seize them; pain and grief and groaning fled away.

12 I am, I am the one comforting you; know whom you were wary of, that you feared a mortal human and a son of a human, who dried up like grass.

13 And you forgot God who made you, who made heaven and founded the earth, and you feared always, all the days, the face of the fury of the one afflicting you; for in the manner that he counseled to take you away—and now where is the fury of the one afflicting you?

14 For when you are saved, he will not stand or delay;

15 because I am your God who troubles the sea and makes her waves sound; the Lord Sabaoth is my name.

16 I will put my words into your mouth and shelter you under the shadow of my hand, with which I established heaven and founded the earth; and he will say to Sion, You are my people.

17 Awake, awake, rise, Ierusalem who drank the cup of fury from the hand of the Lord; for you drank out and emptied the cup of falling, the bowl of fury.

18 And there was no one comforting you from all your children whom you bore, and there was no one holding your hand, not even from all your sons whom you raised up.

19 These two are opposed to you; who will grieve with you? Fall and destruction, famine and sword; who will comfort you?

20 Your sons who are perplexed, who sleep at the end of every exit like a half-boiled beet, who are full of the Lord's fury, weakened through the Lord God.

21 Therefore hear, humbled woman and drunk, not from wine;

22 thus says the Lord God who judges his people, Behold, I have taken from your hand the cup of falling, the bowl of fury, and you will not continue to drink it any longer;

23 and I will cast it into the hands of those who wronged you and those who humbled you, who said to your soul, Bend down, so that we may pass; and you made your back equal to the earth outside for those passing by.

Chapter 52

1 Awake, awake, Sion; put on your strength, Sion, and put on your glory, Ierusalem, the holy city; an uncircumcised and unclean one will no longer continue to pass through you.

2 Shake off the dust and rise, sit, Ierusalem; take off the bond of your neck, captive daughter of Sion.

3 Because thus says the Lord, You were sold for nothing, and you will be redeemed without silver.

4 Thus says the Lord, My people went down into Egypt formerly to sojourn there, and they were led to the Assyrians by force;

5 and now why are you here? Thus says the Lord. Because my people was taken for nothing, marvel and wail; thus says the Lord. Because of you my name is continually blasphemed among the nations.

6 Therefore my people will know my name on that day, that I am he who speaks; I am present,

7 like beauty upon the mountains, like feet of one announcing good news of a report of peace, like one announcing good things, because I will make your salvation audible, saying to Sion, Your God will reign;

8 because the voice of those guarding you was raised, and with the voice they will be glad together, because eyes will see eye to eye when the Lord has mercy on Sion.

9 Let the deserted places of Ierusalem burst forth gladness together, because the Lord had mercy on her and rescued Ierusalem.

10 And the Lord will uncover his holy arm before all the nations, and all the ends of the earth will see the salvation from God.

11 Depart, depart, come out from there, and do not touch an unclean thing; come out of her midst, be separated, those carrying the vessels of the Lord;

12 because you will not come out with trouble or go in flight, for the Lord will go before you, and the one gathering you is the Lord, the God of Israel.

13 Behold, my servant will understand and be exalted and glorified exceedingly.

14 In the manner that many will be astounded at you—thus your appearance will be without glory among humans, and your glory among humans—

15 thus many nations will marvel at him, and kings will hold their mouth shut; because those to whom it was not announced concerning him will see, and those who have not heard will understand. —

Chapter 53

1 Lord, who believed our report? And to whom was the arm of the Lord revealed?

2 We announced before him like a child, like a root in thirsty land; he has no appearance or glory; and we saw him, and he had no appearance or beauty;

3 but his appearance was dishonored, failing beyond all humans, a human who is in a blow and knows to bear sickness, because his face has been turned away; he was dishonored and not reckoned.

4 This one bears our sins and suffers pain concerning us, and we reckoned him to be in toil and in a blow and in mistreatment.

5 But he was wounded because of our lawless deeds and has been made sick because of our sins; the discipline of our peace is upon him; by his bruise we were healed.

6 All of us wandered like sheep; each human wandered on his way; and the Lord delivered him to our sins.

7 And he, because of being mistreated, does not open the mouth; like a sheep he was led to slaughter, and like a lamb voiceless before the one shearing it, thus he does not open his mouth.

8 In the humiliation his judgment was taken away; who will recount his generation? Because his life is taken from the earth, because of the lawless deeds of my people he was led to death.

9 And I will give the evil ones in exchange for his burial and the rich in exchange for his death, because he did not do lawlessness, nor was deceit found in his mouth.

10 And the Lord desires to cleanse him of the blow; if you give for sin, your soul will see long-lived seed; and the Lord desires to take away

11 from the toil of his soul, to show him light and form him with understanding, to justify a righteous one serving many well, and he himself will bear their sins.

12 Therefore he himself will inherit many and divide spoils of the strong, because his soul was delivered to death, and he was reckoned among the lawless; and he himself bore sins of many and was delivered because of their sins.

Chapter 54

1 Be glad, barren woman who does not give birth; burst forth and cry out, woman not in labor, because the children of the desolate woman are many, more than those of the one having the husband, for the Lord said it.

2 Broaden the place of your tent and of your curtains; pitch them, do not spare; lengthen your cords and strengthen your stakes.

3 Spread out yet to the right and to the left, and your seed will inherit nations, and you will settle desolated cities.

4 Do not fear because you were put to shame, nor be abashed because you were reproached, because you will forget eternal shame and certainly not remember the reproach of your widowhood.

5 Because the Lord is the one making you; the Lord Sabaoth is his name; and the one who rescued you is himself the God of Israel; he will be called so in all the earth.

6 The Lord has not called you as an abandoned and fainthearted woman or as a woman hated from youth, said your God;

7 for a little time I abandoned you, and with great mercy I will have mercy on you;

8 in a little fury I turned my face away from you, and with eternal mercy I will have mercy on you, said the Lord who rescued you.

9 From the water in Noe's time this is for me; according as I swore to him at that time concerning the earth, not to be angry at you any longer or, in threatening you,

10 for the mountains to be removed, nor will your hills be moved; thus neither will the mercy from me for you fail, nor will the covenant of your peace be removed; for the Lord said, I am propitious to you.

11 Humble and unsettled woman, you were not comforted; behold, I prepare a carbuncle as your stone and sapphire as your foundations,

12 and I will make your battlements jasper and your gates stones of crystal and your enclosure chosen stones,

13 and all your sons taught by God, and your children in much peace.

14 And in righteousness you will be built; keep away from injustice, and you will not fear, and trembling will not draw near you.

15 Behold, proselytes will approach you through me and flee to you.

16 Behold, I create you, not like a smith blowing coals and bringing forth a vessel for work; but I created you not for destruction, to destroy

17 every perishable vessel. Against you I will not prosper it, and every voice will rise against you for judgment; you will defeat all of them, and those guilty toward you will be in it. There is an inheritance for those serving the Lord, and you will be righteous for me, says the Lord.

Chapter 55

1 Thirsty ones, go for water, and all who have no silver, go, buy and drink without silver and the price of wine, and fat.

2 Why are you valued for silver, and your toil not for fullness? Hear me, and you will eat good things, and your soul will luxuriate in good things.

3 Pay attention with your ears and follow my ways; listen to me, and your soul will live in good things; and I will covenant with you an eternal covenant, the faithful holy things of David.

4 Behold, I have given him as a testimony among nations, a ruler and one commanding nations.

5 Nations which did not know you will call upon you, and peoples which do not understand you will flee to you for the sake of your God, the Holy One of Israel, because he glorified you.

6 Seek God and, when finding him, call upon him; and whenever he draws near you,

7 let the impious one leave his ways and a lawless man his counsels, and let him turn to the Lord, and he will be shown mercy, because he will abundantly forgive your sins.

8 For my counsels are not like your counsels, nor are my ways like your ways, says the Lord;

9 but as heaven is distant from earth, thus my way is distant from your ways, and your thoughts from my mind.

10 For as rain or snow comes down from heaven and certainly does not turn back until it saturates the earth, and she brings forth and sprouts and gives seed to the sower and bread for eating,

11 thus will be my utterance which comes out of my mouth; it will certainly not turn back until whatever I desired is accomplished, and I will prosper your ways and my commands.

12 For in gladness you will go out, and in joy you will be taught; for the mountains and hills will leap out, welcoming you in joy, and all the trees of the field will clap with the branches,

13 and instead of thorny burnet a cypress will come up, and instead of fleabane a myrtle will come up; and the Lord will be for a name and for an eternal sign and will not fail.

Chapter 56

1 Thus says the Lord, Guard judgment, do righteousness, for my salvation drew near to arrive, and my mercy to be revealed.

2 Blessed is a man doing these things and a human clinging to them and guarding the sabbaths so as not to profane them and preserving his hands so as not to do an injustice.

3 Let the foreigner attached to the Lord not say, The Lord will surely separate me from his people; and let the eunuch not say that, I am a dry tree.

4 Thus says the Lord, To the eunuchs, all who guard my sabbaths and choose what I desire and cling to my covenant,

5 I will give them in my house and within my wall a renowned place, better than sons and daughters; I will give them an eternal name, and it will not fail.

6 And the foreigners attached to the Lord to serve him and love the name of the Lord, to be male slaves and female slaves for him, and all those guarding my sabbaths so as not to profane them and clinging to my covenant,

7 I will bring them into my holy mountain and gladden them in my house of prayer; their whole burnt offerings and their sacrifices will be acceptable upon my altar; for my house will be called a house of prayer for all the nations,

8 said the Lord who gathers the scattered ones of Israel, that, I will gather a gathering to him.

9 All the wild beasts, come, eat, all the beasts of the wood.

10 See that all have been blinded; they did not know to understand; all are mute dogs; they will not be able to bark, dreaming of a bed, loving to doze.

11 And the dogs are shameless in soul, not knowing fullness; and they are evil, not knowing understanding; all followed their ways, each according to his own.

Chapter 57

1 See how the righteous one perished, and no one takes it to heart, and righteous men are taken away, and no one considers. For the righteous one has been taken away from the face of injustice;

2 his burial will be in peace; he has been taken away from the midst.

3 But you draw near here, lawless sons, seed of adulterers and of a prostitute;

4 in what did you luxuriate? And against whom did you open your mouth? And against whom did you let loose your tongue? Are you not children of destruction, lawless seed?

5 Those appealing to the idols under dense trees, slaughtering their children in the ravines between the rocks.

6 That is your portion, this your lot, and to those you poured libations and to those you brought up sacrifices; will I therefore not be angry at these things?

7 Upon a high and lofty mountain, there is your bed, and there you brought up sacrifices.

8 And behind the posts of your door you put your memorials; you thought that if you departed from me, you would have something more; you loved those sleeping with you,

9 and multiplied your prostitution with them and made many those far away from you, and sent envoys beyond your boundaries and turned back and were humbled as far as Hades.

10 In your many journeys you labored and did not say, I will cease strengthening myself; because you did these things, therefore you did not supplicate me,

11 you. Whom were you wary of, that you feared and lied to me and did not remember me or take me into your mind or into your heart? And I, seeing you, overlook, and you did not fear me.

12 And I will announce my righteousness and your evils which will not benefit you.

13 When you cry out, let them deliver you in your affliction; for wind will take all these, and a tempest will carry them away. But those clinging to me will acquire land and inherit my holy mountain.

14 And they will say, Clear ways before him and take stumbling blocks away from the way of my people.

15 Thus says the Lord Most High who dwells in lofty places forever, Holy among holy ones is his name, the Lord Most High resting among holy ones and giving patience to fainthearted ones and giving life to those broken in heart:

16 I will not avenge myself upon you forever or be angry with you continually; for a spirit will come out from me, and I made every breath.

17 Because of sin I grieved him a little and struck him and turned my face away from him, and he was grieved and went gloomy in his ways.

18 I have seen his ways and healed him and comforted him and gave him true comfort,

19 peace upon peace to those far away and those who are near; and the Lord said, I will heal them.

20 But the unjust will be tossed thus and will not be able to rest.

21 There is no rejoicing for the impious, said the Lord God.

Chapter 58

1 Cry out in strength and do not spare; lift your voice like a trumpet and announce to my people their sins and to the house of Iakob their lawless deeds.

2 They seek me day by day and desire to know my ways; like a people having done righteousness and not abandoned the judgment of its God, they now ask me for a righteous judgment and desire to draw near God,

3 saying, Why did we fast and you did not see? We humbled our souls and you did not know? For in the days of your fasts you find your desires and goad all those under your hand.

4 If you fast for disputes and fights and strike a humble one with fists, why do you fast for me as today, for your voice to be heard in a cry?

5 I did not choose this fast or a day for a human to humble his soul; not even if you bend your neck like a ring and spread sackcloth and ash beneath you, not even thus will you call it an acceptable fast.

6 I did not choose such a fast, says the Lord, but loose every bond of injustice, dissolve the strangling cords of violent transactions, send the crushed ones away in release, and tear apart every unjust written contract;

7 break your bread for a hungry one and bring roofless poor ones into your house; if you see a naked one, clothe him, and you will not overlook those of the household of your seed.

8 Then your light will burst forth early, and your healings will spring up quickly, and your righteousness will go before you, and the glory of God will surround you;

9 then you will cry out, and God will hear you; while you are still speaking, he will say, Behold, I am present. If you take away from yourself a bond and a pointing of the hand and an utterance of grumbling,

10 and give bread to a hungry one from your soul and fill a humbled soul, then your light will rise in darkness, and your darkness will be like midday.

11 And your God will be with you continually; and you will be filled just as your soul desires, and your bones will be fattened, and you will be like a saturated garden and like a spring whose water did not fail, and your bones will spring up like vegetation and be fattened, and they will inherit for generations of generations.

12 And your eternal deserted places will be built, and your foundations will be eternal for generations of generations; and you will be called Builder of Fences, and you will cause the paths between to cease.

13 If you turn your foot away from the sabbaths so as not to do your desires on the holy day, and you will call the sabbaths delightful, holy to your God, you will not lift your foot for work or speak a word in wrath from your mouth,

14 and you will be trusting in the Lord, and he will bring you up upon the good things of the earth and feed you the inheritance of Iakob your father; for the mouth of the Lord spoke these things.

Chapter 59

1 Does the hand of the Lord lack strength to save? Or did he make his ear heavy so as not to hear?

2 But your sins separate between you and God, and because of your sins he turned his face away from you so as not to have mercy.

3 For your hands are stained with blood and your fingers with sins, and your lips spoke lawlessness, and your tongue meditates injustice.

4 No one speaks righteous things, nor is there a true judgment; they have trusted in vain things and speak empty things, because they conceive toil and give birth to lawlessness.

5 They broke eggs of asps and weave a spider's web; and the one going to eat of their eggs, breaking one, found a wind-egg, and in it a basilisk;

6 their web will not be for a garment, nor will they clothe themselves from their works, for their works are works of lawlessness.

7 And their feet run to wickedness, swift to pour out blood; and their reasonings are reasonings of senseless ones; destruction and misery are in their ways.

8 And they do not know a way of peace, and there is no judgment in their ways; for their paths which they travel are perverted, and they do not know peace.

9 Therefore judgment departed from them, and righteousness will certainly not overtake them; while they waited for light, darkness came to be for them; waiting for brightness, they walked at an untimely hour.

10 They will feel a wall like blind ones, and as though eyes do not exist, they will feel; and they will fall at midday as at midnight; like dying ones they will groan.

11 Like a bear and like a dove they will go together; we waited for judgment, and there is none; salvation has departed far from us.

12 For our lawlessness is abundant before you, and our sins stood against us; for our lawless deeds are within us, and we knew our injustices;

13 we acted impiously and lied and departed from following our God; we spoke unjust things and disobeyed; we conceived and meditated unjust words from our heart;

14 and we pushed judgment backward, and righteousness has departed far away, because truth was consumed in their ways, and they could not pass through by a straight way.

15 And truth has been taken away, and they removed the mind from understanding; and the Lord saw, and it did not please him, because there was no judgment.

16 And he saw, and there was no man, and he considered, and there was no one who would uphold, and he defended against them with his arm and was established by mercy.

17 And he put on righteousness like a breastplate and put a helmet of salvation upon the head and put on a garment of vengeance and the covering,

18 as one who will repay recompense, reproach to the adversaries.

19 And those from the west will fear the name of the Lord, and those from the rising of the sun the glorious name; for the wrath from the Lord will come like a violent river; it will come with fury.

20 And the one rescuing will come for the sake of Sion and turn impieties away from Iakob.

21 And this is the covenant from me for them, said the Lord; my spirit which is upon you, and the utterances which I gave into your mouth, will certainly not fail from your mouth and from the mouth of your seed, for the Lord said it, from now and forever.

Chapter 60

1 Be illumined, be illumined, Ierusalem, for your light has come, and the glory of the Lord has risen upon you.

2 Behold, darkness and gloom will cover earth over nations; but upon you the Lord will appear, and his glory will be seen upon you.

3 And kings will go by your light and nations by your brightness.

4 Lift your eyes around and see your children gathered; behold, all your sons have come from far away, and your daughters will be lifted upon shoulders.

5 Then you will see and fear and be astounded in heart, because wealth of sea and nations and peoples will turn to you. And there will come to you

6 herds of camels, and camels of Madiam and Gaipha will cover you; all will come from Saba, carrying gold, and bring frankincense and announce the good news of the Lord's salvation.

7 And all the sheep of Kedar will be gathered to you, and rams of Nabaioth will come to you, and they will be brought up acceptably upon my altar, and my house of prayer will be glorified.

8 Who are these who fly like clouds and like doves with chicks?

9 Islands waited for me, and ships of Tharsis among the first, to bring your children from far away, and silver and gold with them, because of the holy name of the Lord and because the Holy One of Israel is glorious.

10 And foreigners will build your walls, and their kings will stand beside you; for because of my wrath I struck you, and because of mercy I loved you.

11 And your gates will be opened continually; by day and night they will not be shut, to bring to you the power of nations and kings being led.

12 For the nations and kings who will not serve you will perish, and the nations will be desolated with desolation.

13 And the glory of Lebanon will come to you in cypress and pine and cedar together, to glorify my holy place.

14 And sons of those who humbled you and provoked you will go to you in fear, and you will be called City of the Lord, Sion of the Holy One of Israel.

15 Because you have become abandoned and hated, and there was no one helping, I will also make you an eternal exultation, a gladness for generations of generations.

16 And you will suck milk of nations and eat wealth of kings, and you will know that I am the Lord who saves you and delivers you, the God of Israel.

17 And instead of bronze I will bring you gold, and instead of iron I will bring you silver, and instead of wood I will bring you bronze, and instead of stones iron. And I will give your rulers in peace and your overseers in righteousness;

18 and injustice will no longer be heard in your land, nor destruction or misery within your boundaries, but your walls will be called Salvation, and your gates Carving.

19 And the sun will not be for you for light of day, nor will the rising of the moon illumine the night for you, but the Lord will be an eternal light for you, and God your glory.

20 For the sun will not set for you, and the moon will not fail for you; for the Lord will be an eternal light for you, and the days of your mourning will be fulfilled.

21 And your people are all righteous, and forever they will inherit the earth, he guarding the planting, works of his hands for glory.

22 The very small one will become thousands, and the least one a great nation; I, the Lord, will gather them at the time.

Chapter 61

1 The spirit of the Lord is upon me, because of which he anointed me; he has sent me to announce good news to poor ones, to heal those broken in heart, to proclaim release to captives and recovery of sight to blind ones,

2 to call an acceptable year of the Lord and a day of recompense, to comfort all those mourning,

3 for glory to be given to those mourning Sion instead of ash, an anointing of gladness to those mourning, an attire of glory instead of a spirit of despondency; and they will be called generations of righteousness, a planting of the Lord for glory.

4 And they will build eternal deserted places, raise up those desolated formerly, and renew deserted cities desolated for generations.

5 And foreigners will come shepherding your sheep, and those of another tribe as plowmen and vinedressers;

6 but you will be called priests of the Lord, ministers of God; you will devour the strength of nations and be marveled at in their wealth.

7 Thus a second time they will inherit the earth, and eternal gladness will be above their head.

8 For I am the Lord who loves righteousness and hates things seized through injustice; and I will give their toil to righteous ones and covenant an eternal covenant with them.

9 And their seed and their offspring will be known among the nations; everyone seeing them will recognize them, that these are seed blessed by God,

10 and with gladness they will be glad in the Lord. — Let my soul exult in the Lord, for he clothed me with a garment of salvation and a tunic of gladness; like a bridegroom he put a headdress upon me, and like a bride he adorned me with adornment.

11 And like earth growing its flower and like a garden its seeds, thus the Lord will bring forth righteousness and exultation before all the nations.

Chapter 62

1 Because of Sion I will not be silent, and because of Ierusalem I will not desist, until my righteousness comes forth like light, and my salvation will burn like a torch.

2 And nations will see your righteousness and kings your glory, and he will call you by your new name which the Lord will name.

3 And you will be a crown of beauty in the hand of the Lord and a diadem of kingship in the hand of your God.

4 And you will no longer be called Abandoned, and your land will not be called Desert; for you will be called My Desire, and your land Inhabited.

5 And like a young man living with a virgin, thus your sons will dwell with you; and it shall be in the manner that a bridegroom will be glad over a bride, thus the Lord will be glad over you.

6 And upon your walls, Ierusalem, I appointed guards the whole day and the whole night, who to the end will not be silent, remembering the Lord.

7 For there is none like you, if he establishes and makes Ierusalem a boast upon the earth.

8 The Lord swore by his right hand and by the strength of his arm, Surely I will not give your grain and your foods to your enemies any longer, and surely foreign sons will not drink your wine for which you toiled any longer;

9 but those gathering will eat them and praise the Lord, and those gathering will drink them in my holy dwellings.

10 Go through my gates and make a road for my people and scatter the stones out of the way; raise a signal to the nations.

11 For behold, the Lord made it audible as far as the furthest part of the earth, Say to the daughter of Sion, Behold, your Savior arrives, having his own wage and the work before his face.

12 And he will call him a holy people redeemed by the Lord, but you will be called a sought-after city and not abandoned.

Chapter 63

1 Who is this who arrives from Edom, a redness of garments from Bosor, thus beautiful in a robe, with violence, with strength? I discourse righteousness and a judgment of salvation.

2 Why are your garments red and your clothes as from a treader of a winepress?

3 Full of what has been trampled, and of the nations there is no man with me, and I trampled them in fury and crushed them like earth and brought their blood down to earth.

4 For a day of recompense came upon them, and a year of redemption is present.

5 And I looked, and there was no helper; and I considered, and no one upheld; and my arm rescued them, and my fury came upon them.

6 And I trampled them in my wrath and brought their blood down to earth.

7 I remembered the mercy of the Lord, the excellences of the Lord in everything which the Lord repays to us; the Lord is a good judge for the house of Israel; he brings upon us according to his mercy and according to the abundance of his righteousness.

8 And he said, Are not my people children who will certainly not reject? And he became salvation for them

9 from every affliction. Not an envoy or an angel, but the Lord himself saved them because he loved them and spared them; he himself redeemed them and took them up and raised them up all the days of eternity.

10 But they disobeyed and provoked his holy spirit, and he turned to enmity toward them, and he himself warred against them.

11 And the one who brought up the shepherd of the sheep from the earth remembered eternal days; where is the one who put the holy spirit among them?

12 The one who led Moyses by the right hand, the arm of his glory? He prevailed over water before him to make an eternal name for himself.

13 He led them through the abyss like a horse through a desert, and they did not grow weary.

14 And like livestock through a plain, a spirit came down from the Lord and guided them; thus you led your people to make yourself a name of glory.

15 Turn from heaven and see from the house of your holiness and glory; where are your zeal and your strength? Where is the abundance of your mercy and your compassions, that you held back from us?

16 For you are our father, because Abraam did not know us, and Israel did not recognize us, but you, Lord, are our father; rescue us; from the beginning your name is upon us.

17 Why did you lead us astray, Lord, from your way, harden our hearts so as not to fear you? Turn back because of your slaves, because of the tribes of your inheritance,

18 so that we may inherit a little of your holy mountain; our adversaries trampled your sanctuary.

19 We became as at the beginning, when you did not rule us, nor was your name called upon us. If you open heaven, trembling will seize mountains because of you, and they will melt,

Chapter 64

1 as wax melts from fire. And fire will burn up the adversaries, and the name of the Lord will be manifest among the adversaries; before you nations will be troubled.

2 When you do the glorious things, trembling will seize mountains because of you.

3 From eternity we did not hear, nor did our eyes see a god apart from you, and your works which you will do for those waiting for mercy.

4 For he will meet those doing justice, and they will remember your ways. Behold, you were angry, and we sinned; therefore we were led astray.

5 And we all became like unclean ones; all our righteousness is like the rag of a menstruating woman; and we flowed away like leaves because of our lawless deeds; thus wind will carry us.

6 And there is no one calling upon your name and remembering to take hold of you, because you turned your face away from us and delivered us over because of our sins. —

7 And now, Lord, you are our father, and we are clay, all a work of your hands;

8 do not be very angry with us and do not remember our sins at a time. And now look, because all of us are your people.

9 The city of your holy one became desolate; Sion became like a desert; Ierusalem became a curse.

10 The house, our holy place, and the glory which our fathers blessed became burned by fire, and all the glorious things fell together.

11 And at all these things you held back, Lord, and were silent and humbled us exceedingly.

Chapter 65

1 I became manifest to those not seeking me; I was found by those not inquiring of me; I said, Behold, I am, to the nation who did not call my name.

2 I spread out my hands the whole day toward a disobedient and contradicting people, who did not go by a true way, but after their sins.

3 This people who provokes me before me continually—they sacrifice in the gardens and burn incense upon the bricks to the demons which do not exist;

4 and in the tombs and in the caves they sleep for dreams, those eating pork and broth of sacrifices; all their vessels are stained;

5 those saying, Far away from me, do not draw near me, because I am clean; this is smoke of my fury; fire burns in it all the days.

6 Behold, it is written before me, I will not be silent until I repay into their bosom;

7 their sins and those of their fathers, says the Lord, who burned incense upon the mountains and reproached me upon the hills—I will repay their works into their bosom.

8 Thus says the Lord, In the manner that a grape berry will be found in the cluster, and they will say, Do not ruin it, because a blessing of the Lord is in it, thus I will do for the sake of the one serving me; for this one's sake I will certainly not destroy all.

9 And I will bring out the seed from Iakob and that from Iouda, and it will inherit my holy mountain, and my chosen ones and my slaves will inherit and dwell there.

10 And in the wood there will be dwellings of flocks, and a ravine of Achor for a resting place of herds for my people who sought me.

11 But you who abandoned me and forget my holy mountain and prepare a table for the demon and fill a mixed drink for Fortune,

12 I will deliver you to a sword; all will fall in slaughter, because I called you and you did not obey; I spoke and you disregarded and did evil before me and chose what I did not desire.

13 Therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, those serving me will eat, but you will hunger; behold, those serving me will drink, but you will thirst; behold, those serving me will be glad, but you will be ashamed;

14 behold, those serving me will exult in gladness, but you will cry out because of the toil of your heart and wail from a breaking of spirit.

15 For you will leave your name for fullness to my chosen ones, but the Lord will kill you. But for those serving him a new name will be called,

16 which will be blessed upon the earth; for they will bless the true God, and those swearing upon the earth will swear by the true God; for they will forget their former affliction, and it will not rise upon their heart. —

17 For heaven will be new and the earth new, and they will certainly not remember the former things, nor will they come upon their heart,

18 but they will find gladness and exultation in her, because behold, I make Ierusalem an exultation and my people a gladness.

19 And I will exult over Ierusalem and be glad over my people, and a voice of weeping or a voice of crying will certainly no longer be heard in her.

20 And there will certainly not be there one untimely or an elder who will not fulfill his time; for the young one will be a hundred years old, and the sinner dying a hundred years old will also be accursed.

21 And they will build houses and themselves dwell in them and plant vineyards and themselves eat their produce;

22 and they will certainly not build and others dwell in them, and they will certainly not plant and others eat; for according to the days of the tree of life will be the days of my people; they will make old the works of their toils.

23 But my chosen ones will not labor in emptiness or produce children for a curse, because they are seed blessed by God, and their offspring will be with them.

24 And it shall be that before they cry out, I will listen to them; while they are still speaking, I will say, What is it?

25 Then wolves and lambs will graze together, and a lion will eat straw like an ox, and a snake earth like bread; they will not do wrong or ruin upon my holy mountain, says the Lord.

Chapter 66

1 Thus says the Lord, Heaven is my throne, and the earth a footstool for my feet; what house will you build for me? Or what place of my rest?

2 For my hand made all these things, and all these things are mine, says the Lord; and upon whom will I look except upon the humble and quiet one trembling at my words?

3 But the lawless one sacrificing a calf to me is like the one killing a dog, and the one bringing up fine flour like swine's blood, the one giving frankincense for a memorial like a blasphemer; and these chose their ways and their abominations which their soul desired,

4 and I will choose their mockeries and repay their sins to them, because I called them and they did not obey me; I spoke and they did not hear, and they did evil before me and chose what I did not desire.

5 Hear the utterance of the Lord, those trembling at his word; say, our brothers, to those hating us and abhorring us, so that the name of the Lord may be glorified and seen in their gladness, and those will be ashamed.

6 A voice of crying from a city, a voice from a temple, a voice of the Lord repaying recompense to the opponents.

7 Before the woman in labor gave birth, before the pain of the pangs came, she escaped and bore a male.

8 Who heard such a thing, and who has seen thus? Did a land labor in one day, or was a nation also born at once? Because Sion labored and bore her children.

9 But I gave this expectation, and you did not remember me, said the Lord. Did I not, behold, make one giving birth and one barren? said God.

10 Be glad, Ierusalem, and celebrate in her, all those loving her; rejoice with joy, all who mourn over her,

11 so that you may suck and be filled from the breast of her comfort, so that, sucking out, you may delight from the entrance of her glory.

12 Because thus says the Lord, Behold, I turn toward them like a river of peace and like an overflowing torrent the glory of nations; their children will be lifted upon shoulders and comforted upon knees.

13 As if a mother comforts someone, thus I too will comfort you, and in Ierusalem you will be comforted.

14 And you will see, and your heart will rejoice, and your bones will spring up like vegetation; and the hand of the Lord will be known to those revering him, and he will threaten the disobedient.

15 For behold, the Lord will come like fire, and his chariots like a tempest, to repay vengeance in fury and expulsion in a flame of fire.

16 For by the fire of the Lord all the earth will be judged, and by his sword all flesh; many will be wounded by the Lord.

17 Those purifying and cleansing themselves for the gardens, and in the porches eating pork and the abominations and the now, will be consumed together, said the Lord,

18 and I know their works and their reasoning. I come to gather all the nations and tongues, and they will come and see my glory.

19 And I will leave signs upon them and send saved ones from them to the nations, to Tharsis and Phoud and Loud and Mosoch and Thobel and into Hellas and into the distant islands, who have not heard my name or seen my glory, and they will announce my glory among the nations.

20 And they will bring your brothers from all the nations as a gift to the Lord, with horses and chariots, in mule carriages with canopies, into the holy city Ierusalem, said the Lord, as the sons of Israel would bring me their sacrifices with psalms into the house of the Lord.

21 And from them I will take priests and Leuites for myself, said the Lord.

22 For in the manner that the new heaven and the new earth which I make remain before me, says the Lord, thus your seed and your name will stand.

23 And it shall be month after month and sabbath after sabbath that all flesh will come before me to worship in Ierusalem, said the Lord.

24 And they will come out and see the limbs of the humans who have transgressed against me; for their worm will not die, and their fire will not be extinguished, and they will be a sight for all flesh.

Jeremiah

Chapter 1

1 The utterance of God which came upon Ieremias, the son of Chelkias, from the priests, who dwelt in Anathoth in the land of Beniamin;

2 which became a word of God to him in the days of Iosias son of Amos, king of Iouda, in the thirteenth year of his reign;

3 and it came in the days of Ioakim son of Iosias, king of Iouda, until the eleventh year of Sedekias son of Iosias, king of Iouda, until the captivity of Ierusalem in the fifth month.

4 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

5 Before I formed you in the womb I know you, and before you came out of the womb I have sanctified you; I have appointed you a prophet to nations.

6 And I said, O Master Lord, behold, I do not know how to speak, because I am young.

7 And the Lord said to me, Do not say that, I am young, because to all to whom I send you away you will go, and according to everything that I command you, you will speak;

8 do not fear before them, because I am with you to deliver you, says the Lord.

9 And the Lord stretched his hand toward me and touched my mouth, and the Lord said to me, Behold, I have given my words into your mouth;

10 behold, I have appointed you today over nations and kingdoms, to uproot and dig down and destroy and rebuild and plant.

11 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying, What do you see, Ieremias? And I said, A rod of nut wood.

12 And the Lord said to me, You have seen well, because I have kept watch over my words to do them. —

13 And a word of the Lord came to me a second time, saying, What do you see? And I said, A cauldron heated from beneath, and its face from the face of the north.

14 And the Lord said to me, From the face of the north evils will blaze out upon all those dwelling on the earth.

15 Because behold, I call together all the kingdoms from the north of the earth, says the Lord, and they will come and each set his throne at the porches of the gates of Ierusalem and against all the walls around her and against all the cities of Iouda.

16 And I will speak to them with judgment concerning all their wickedness, how they abandoned me and sacrificed to foreign gods and worshiped the works of their hands.

17 And you gird your waist and rise and say to them everything that I command you; do not fear before them or be frightened before them, because I am with you to deliver you, says the Lord.

18 Behold, I have made you on this day like a strong city and like a strong bronze wall to all the kings of Iouda and its rulers and the people of the land,

19 and they will war against you and certainly not prevail against you, because I am with you to deliver you, said the Lord.

2 And he said, Thus says the Lord, I remembered the mercy of your youth and the love of your completion, that you followed the Holy One of Israel, says the Lord,

3 holy Israel. To the Lord he is the beginning of his produce; all those eating him will offend; evils will come upon them, declares the Lord.

4 Hear a word of the Lord, house of Iakob and every family of the house of Israel.

5 Thus says the Lord, What offense did your fathers find in me, that they departed far from me and went after vain things and were made vain?

6 And they did not say, Where is the Lord who brought us up from the land of Egypt, who guided us in the desert, in an unbounded and untrodden land, in a waterless and fruitless land, in a land in which nothing traveled and no son of a human dwelt there?

7 And I brought you into Karmel for you to eat its fruits and its good things; and you entered and defiled my land and made my inheritance an abomination.

8 The priests did not say, Where is the Lord? And those clinging to the law did not know me, and the shepherds acted impiously toward me, and the prophets prophesied by Baal and went after a useless thing.

9 Therefore I will yet contend with you, says the Lord, and with the sons of your sons I will contend.

10 Because cross into the islands of Chettiim and see, and send into Kedar and consider exceedingly, and see whether such things have happened.

11 Will nations exchange their gods? And these are not gods. But my people exchanged its glory, from which they will not be benefited.

12 Heaven was astounded at this and shuddered exceedingly, beyond measure, says the Lord.

13 Because my people did two evil things; they abandoned me, a spring of water of life, and dug for themselves broken cisterns which will not be able to hold water.

14 Is Israel a slave or house-born? Why did he become plunder?

15 Lions roared against him and gave their voice, who made his land a desert, and his cities were dug down so as not to be inhabited.

16 And sons of Memphis and Taphnas knew you and mocked you.

17 Did not your abandoning me do these things to you? says the Lord your God.

18 And now what have you to do with the way of Egypt, to drink water of Geon? And what have you to do with the way of the Assyrians, to drink water of rivers?

19 Your apostasy will discipline you, and your wickedness will reprove you; and know and see that your abandoning me is bitter for you, says the Lord your God; and I was not pleased with you, says the Lord your God.

20 Because from eternity you shattered your yoke, tore apart your bonds and said, I will not serve, but I will go upon every high hill and beneath every shady tree; there I will abandon myself to my prostitution.

21 But I planted you a fruitful vine, entirely true; how were you turned to bitterness, the foreign vine?

22 If you wash yourself with natron and multiply cleansing herb for yourself, you have been stained in your injustices before me, says the Lord.

23 How will you say, I was not defiled and did not go after Baal? See your ways in the burial ground and know what you did. Late her voice wailed; her ways

24 she broadened toward waters of a desert; in desires of her soul she was borne by a spirit, she was delivered over; who will turn her back? All those seeking her will not grow weary; in her humiliation they will find her.

25 Turn your foot away from a rough way and your throat from thirst. But she said, I will be courageous; because she had loved strangers and went after them.

26 As the shame of a thief when he is captured, thus the sons of Israel will be ashamed, they and their kings and their rulers and their priests and their prophets.

27 To the wood they said that, You are my father, and to the stone, You begot me, and they turned backs toward me and not their faces; and in the time of their evils they will say, Rise and save us.

28 And where are your gods which you made for yourself? Will they rise and save you in a time of your mistreatment? Because according to the number of your cities were your gods, Iouda, and according to the number of passages of Ierusalem they sacrificed to Baal.

29 Why do you speak to me? All of you acted impiously and all of you acted lawlessly toward me, says the Lord.

30 In vain I struck your children; you did not accept discipline; a sword devoured your prophets like a destroying lion, and you did not fear.

31 Hear a word of the Lord, Thus says the Lord, Did I become a desert for Israel or a land made barren? Why did my people say, We will not be ruled and will not come to you any longer?

32 Will a bride forget her adornment and a virgin her breastband? But my people forgot me for days of which there is no number.

33 What good thing will you yet pursue in your ways to seek love? Not thus, but you too acted wickedly to defile your ways.

34 And in your hands blood of innocent souls was found; I did not find them in break-ins, but upon every oak.

35 And you said, I am innocent, but let his fury turn away from me. Behold, I contend with you in your saying, I did not sin.

36 Why did you greatly disdain to repeat your ways? And because of Egypt you will be put to shame, just as you were put to shame because of Assour.

37 Because from here too you will go out, and your hands upon your head, because the Lord rejected your hope, and you will not prosper in it.

Chapter 3

1 If a man sends his wife away, and she departs from him and becomes another man's, will she, returning, still return to him? Will that woman not, being defiled, be defiled? And you prostituted yourself among many shepherds; and were you returning to me? says the Lord.

2 Lift your eyes straight ahead and see; where were you not stained? Upon the ways you sat for them like a deserted crow and defiled the land in your prostitutions and in your wickedness.

3 And you had many shepherds as a stumbling block for yourself; you acquired the appearance of a prostitute; you were utterly shameless toward all.

4 Did you not call me as a house and father and leader of your virginity?

5 Will it remain forever or be preserved for strife? Behold, you spoke and did these evil things and prevailed.

6 And the Lord said to me in the days of Iosias the king, You saw what the dwelling of Israel did to me; they went upon every high mountain and beneath every wooded tree and prostituted themselves there.

7 And I said after she prostituted herself in all these things, Return to me, and she did not return; and faithless Iouda saw her faithlessness.

8 And I saw that, concerning all the things in which the dwelling of Israel was caught committing adultery, I also sent her away and gave her a document of divorce into her hands; and faithless Iouda did not fear and went and prostituted herself too.

9 And her prostitution became nothing, and she committed adultery with the wood and the stone.

10 And in all these things faithless Iouda did not turn to me from her whole heart, but in falsehood.

11 And the Lord said to me, Israel justified his soul in comparison with faithless Iouda.

12 Go and read these words toward the north, and you will say, Turn to me, dwelling of Israel, says the Lord, and I will not set my face against you, because I am merciful, says the Lord, and I will not be wrathful toward you forever.

13 Only know your injustice, because you acted impiously toward the Lord your God and spread your ways to strangers beneath every wooded tree, but you did not obey my voice, says the Lord.

14 Turn back, departed sons, says the Lord, because I will rule over you and take you, one from a city and two from a family, and bring you into Sion,

15 and I will give you shepherds according to my heart, and they will shepherd you, shepherding with knowledge.

16 And it shall be, if you are multiplied and increased upon the earth in those days, says the Lord, they will no longer say, Ark of the covenant of the Holy One of Israel; it will not rise upon the heart, it will not be named or visited and will not be made any longer;

17 in those days and at that time they will call Ierusalem Throne of the Lord, and all the nations will be gathered into her and will no longer go after the thoughts of their evil heart.

18 In those days the house of Iouda will come together to the house of Israel, and they will come together from the land of the north and from all the countries to the land which I gave their fathers to inherit.

19 And I said, May it be, Lord, because I will set you among children and give you a chosen land, an inheritance of God Almighty of nations; and I said, You will call me Father and will not turn away from me.

20 Only, as a woman deals faithlessly with the one living with her, thus the house of Israel dealt faithlessly with me, says the Lord.

21 A voice was heard from lips, of weeping and supplication of sons of Israel, because they did wrong in their ways, forgot their holy God.

22 Turn back, returning sons, and I will heal your fractures. Behold, we will be slaves to you, because you are the Lord our God.

23 Truly the hills and the power of the mountains were for falsehood, but through the Lord our God is the salvation of Israel.

24 But shame consumed the toils of our fathers from our youth, their sheep and their calves and their sons and their daughters.

25 We slept in our shame, and our dishonor covered us, because before our God we sinned, we and our fathers, from our youth until this day, and we did not obey the voice of the Lord our God.

Chapter 4

1 If Israel turns back, says the Lord, he will turn to me; if he removes his abominations from his mouth and is wary before me,

2 and swears, The Lord lives, with truth and in judgment and in righteousness, nations will also bless in her and in him praise God in Ierusalem.

3 Because thus says the Lord to the men of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem, Break up fallow ground for yourselves and do not sow upon thorns.

4 Be circumcised to your God and circumcise your hardness of heart, men of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem, lest my fury come out like fire and blaze up, and there will be no one extinguishing, because of the wickedness of your practices.

5 Announce in Iouda, and let it be heard in Ierusalem; say, Signal upon the earth with a trumpet and cry out greatly; say, Be gathered, and let us enter the walled cities.

6 Taking up, flee to Sion; hasten, do not stand, because I bring evils from the north and great destruction.

7 A lion went up from his lair; one destroying nations set out and came out from his place to make the earth a desolation, and cities will be pulled down so as not to be inhabited.

8 At these things gird yourselves with sackcloth and beat yourselves and raise a cry, because the fury of the Lord did not turn away from you.

9 And it shall be on that day, says the Lord, that the heart of the king and the heart of the rulers will perish, and the priests will be astounded, and the prophets will marvel.

10 And I said, O Master Lord, surely, deceiving, you deceived this people and Ierusalem, saying, There will be peace for you, and behold, the sword reached as far as their soul.

11 At that time they will say to this people and to Ierusalem, A spirit of wandering in the desert; the way of the daughter of my people is not toward what is clean or toward what is holy.

12 A spirit of fullness will come to me; but now I speak judgments to them.

13 Behold, he will go up like a cloud, and his chariots like a tempest; his horses are swifter than eagles; woe to us, because we suffer misery.

14 Wash your heart from wickedness, Ierusalem, so that you may be saved; until when will reasonings of your toils exist in you?

15 Because a voice of one announcing will come from Dan, and toil will be heard from Mount Ephraim.

16 Remind nations, Behold, they have come; announce in Ierusalem, Gathered bands come from a land far away and gave their voice against the cities of Iouda.

17 Like those guarding a field they came against her all around, because you neglected me, says the Lord.

18 Your ways and your practices did these things to you; this is your wickedness, because it is bitter, because it reached as far as your heart.

19 My belly, my belly, I suffer pain, and the organs of my heart; my soul rages, my heart is torn; I will not be silent, because my soul heard a voice of a trumpet, a cry of war.

20 And it calls misery destruction, because all the earth has suffered misery; suddenly the tent has suffered misery; my tent coverings were torn apart.

21 Until when will I see those fleeing, hearing a voice of trumpets?

22 Because those leading my people did not know me; they are senseless sons and not intelligent; they are wise in doing evil, but they did not recognize doing good.

23 I looked upon the earth, and behold, nothing, and toward heaven, and its lights were not there;

24 I saw the mountains, and they were trembling, and all the hills troubled;

25 I looked, and behold, there was no human, and all the birds of heaven were frightened;

26 I saw, and behold, Karmel was desolate, and all the cities burned with fire before the Lord, and before the wrath of his fury they disappeared.

27 Thus says the Lord, All the earth will be desolate, but I will certainly not make an end.

28 At these things let the earth mourn, and let heaven above grow dark, because I spoke and will not repent; I set out and will not turn away from her.

29 From the sound of a horseman and a drawn bow every country withdrew; they slipped into the caves and hid in the groves and went up upon the rocks; every city was abandoned; no human dwells in them.

30 And what will you do, if you put on scarlet and adorn yourself with golden adornment and if you paint your eyes with antimony? Your beautification is in vain; your lovers rejected you; they seek your soul.

31 Because I heard a voice like a woman in labor, of your groaning like one giving birth for the first time, a voice of the daughter of Sion; she will grow weak and let her hands drop, Alas for me, because my soul fails over those killed.

Chapter 5

1 Run around in the ways of Ierusalem and see and know and seek in her squares, if you find a man, if there is one doing judgment and seeking faithfulness, and I will be propitious to them, says the Lord.

2 The Lord lives, they say; do they not therefore swear upon falsehoods?

3 Lord, your eyes are toward faithfulness; you scourged them, and they did not suffer; you made an end of them, and they did not desire to accept discipline; they made their faces harder than rock and did not desire to turn back.

4 And I said, Perhaps they are poor, because they had no strength, because they did not know a way of the Lord and a judgment of God;

5 I will go to the great ones and speak to them, because they recognized a way of the Lord and a judgment of God; and behold, with one accord they shattered a yoke, tore apart bonds.

6 Therefore a lion from the wood struck them, and a wolf as far as the houses destroyed them, and a leopard kept watch against their cities; all those going out from them will be hunted, because they multiplied their impieties, were strong in their turnings away.

7 For which of these shall I become propitious to you? Your sons abandoned me and swore by those who are not gods; and I fed them, and they committed adultery and lodged in houses of prostitutes.

8 They became horses mad for females; each neighed toward his neighbor's wife.

9 Will I not visit for these things? says the Lord; or will my soul not avenge itself upon such a nation?

10 Go up upon her battlements and dig down, but do not make an end; leave her supports, because they are the Lord's.

11 Because, rejecting, the house of Israel and the house of Iouda rejected me, says the Lord.

12 They lied to their own Lord and said, These things are not; evils will not come upon us, and we will not see sword and famine;

13 our prophets were for wind, and a word of the Lord did not exist in them; thus it will be for them.

14 Therefore thus says the Lord Almighty, Because you spoke this utterance, behold, I have made my words in your mouth fire and this people wood, and it will devour them.

15 Behold, I bring a nation upon you from far away, house of Israel, says the Lord, a nation of whose tongue you will not understand the voice;

16 all are strong

17 and will devour your harvest and your bread and devour your sons and your daughters and devour your sheep and your calves and devour your vineyards and your fig orchards and your olive groves; and they will thresh your strong cities in which you have trusted, with a sword.

18 And it shall be in those days, says the Lord your God, I will certainly not make an end of you.

19 And it shall be when you say, For what reason did the Lord our God do all these things to us? And you will say to them, As you served foreign gods in your land, thus you will serve foreigners in a land not yours.

20 Announce these things to the house of Iakob, and let it be heard in Iouda.

21 Hear indeed these things, foolish and heartless people; they have eyes and do not see; they have ears and do not hear.

22 Will you not fear me? says the Lord, or will you not be wary before me? The one who appointed sand as a boundary for the sea, an eternal ordinance, and she will not cross it, and she will be troubled and will not be able, and her waves will sound and she will not cross it.

23 But this people acquired an unhearing and disobedient heart, and they turned aside and departed;

24 and they did not say in their heart, Let us indeed fear the Lord our God who gives us early and late rain at a time of fulfillment of the ordinance of harvest, and he guarded it for us.

25 Your lawless deeds turned these things aside, and your sins removed the good things from you;

26 because impious ones were found among my people, and they set snares to destroy men and were capturing them.

27 Like a set snare full of birds, thus their houses are full of deceit; therefore they grew great and rich;

28 and they transgressed judgment, did not judge an orphan's judgment, and did not judge a widow's judgment.

29 Will I not visit for these things? says the Lord, or will my soul not avenge itself upon such a nation?

30 Astonishment and fearful things happened upon the earth.

31 The prophets prophesy unjust things, and the priests clapped with their hands, and my people loved it thus; and what will you do afterward?

Chapter 6

1 Grow strong, sons of Beniamin, from the midst of Ierusalem, and in Thekoue signal with a trumpet, and above Baithacharma raise a sign, because evils have peered out from the north, and great destruction comes to be,

2 and your height will be taken away, daughter of Sion.

3 Shepherds and their flocks will come into her and pitch tents against her all around, and each will shepherd with his hand.

4 Prepare yourselves against her for war; rise, and let us go up against her at midday; woe to us, because the day has inclined, because the shadows of evening fail.

5 Rise, and let us go up by night and destroy her foundations.

6 Because thus says the Lord, Cut out her trees; pour out a force against Ierusalem; O false city, she is entirely oppression.

7 As a cistern cools water, thus her wickedness cools; impiety and misery will be heard in her before her continually. With toil and scourge

8 you will be disciplined, Ierusalem, lest my soul depart from you, lest I make you an untrodden land which will not be inhabited.

9 Because thus says the Lord, Glean, glean like a vine the remnants of Israel; turn back like the one harvesting toward his basket.

10 To whom shall I speak and testify, and he will hear? Behold, their ears are uncircumcised, and they cannot hear; behold, the utterance of the Lord became a reproach for them; they will certainly not desire to hear it.

11 And I filled my fury and held back and did not make an end of them; I will pour it out upon infants outside and upon a gathering of young men together, because man and woman will be captured, an elder with one full of days;

12 and their houses will be turned over to others, fields and their wives together, because I will stretch my hand against those dwelling in this land, says the Lord.

13 Because from their small one even to the great one all accomplished lawless things; from priest even to false prophet all did false things.

14 And they healed the fracture of my people, treating it as nothing and saying, Peace, peace; and where is peace?

15 They were put to shame, because they failed; and not even thus, being ashamed, were they put to shame, and they did not know their dishonor. Therefore they will fall in their fall and perish at the time of their visitation, said the Lord.

16 Thus says the Lord, Stand upon the ways and see, and ask for the eternal paths of the Lord and see what is the good way, and walk in it, and you will find purification for your souls; and they said, We will not go.

17 I have appointed watchmen over you; hear the voice of the trumpet; and they said, We will not hear.

18 Therefore the nations heard, and those shepherding their flocks.

19 Hear, earth; behold, I bring evils upon this people, the fruit of their turning away, because they did not pay attention to my words and rejected my law.

20 Why do you bring frankincense from Saba to me and cinnamon from a land far away? Your whole burnt offerings are not acceptable, and your sacrifices did not please me.

21 Therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, I give weakness upon this people, and in it fathers and sons together will be weak; a neighbor and the one near him will perish.

22 Thus says the Lord, Behold, a people comes from the north, and nations will be raised from the furthest part of the earth;

23 they will hold bow and spear; it is bold and will not have mercy; its voice is like a surging sea; upon horses and chariots it will form up like fire for war against you, daughter of Sion.

24 We heard their report; our hands were paralyzed; affliction held us, pangs like a woman giving birth.

25 Do not go out into a field and do not walk in the ways, because a sword of the enemies sojourns all around.

26 Daughter of my people, gird yourself with sackcloth, sprinkle yourself with ash, make for yourself mourning for a beloved one, a pitiable beating, because suddenly misery will come upon you.

27 I have given you as an assayer among tested peoples, and you will know me when I test their way;

28 all are unhearing, going crookedly, bronze and iron; all are corrupted.

29 A bellows failed from fire, lead failed; in emptiness a silversmith works silver; their wickedness did not melt.

30 Call them rejected silver, because the Lord rejected them.

2 Hear a word of the Lord, all Ioudaia;

3 thus says the Lord, the God of Israel, Correct your ways and your practices, and I will settle you in this place.

4 Do not trust in yourselves, in false words, because they will not benefit you at all, saying, Temple of the Lord, temple of the Lord it is.

5 Because if, correcting, you correct your ways and your practices and, doing, you do judgment between a man and his neighbor,

6 and do not oppress a proselyte and an orphan and a widow and do not pour out innocent blood in this place and do not go after foreign gods to your harm,

7 I will also settle you in this place, in a land which I gave to your fathers from eternity and until eternity.

8 But if you have trusted in false words from which you will not be benefited,

9 and you murder and commit adultery and steal and swear unjustly and burned incense to Baal and went after foreign gods whom you do not know, so that it may be bad for you,

10 and you came and stood before me in the house upon which my name has been called, and said, We have refrained from not doing all these abominations,

11 is my house upon which my name has been called there a cave of robbers before you? And behold, I too have seen, says the Lord.

12 Because go into my place in Selom, where I made my name dwell formerly, and see what I did to it because of the wickedness of my people Israel.

13 And now, because you did all these works, and I spoke to you and you did not hear me, and I called you and you did not answer,

14 I will also do to this house upon which my name has been called, in which you have trusted, and to the place which I gave to you and to your fathers, just as I did to Selom.

15 And I will cast you away from before me, just as I cast away your brothers, all the seed of Ephraim.

16 And you do not pray concerning this people and do not request that they be shown mercy and do not make supplication and do not approach me concerning them, because I will not hear.

17 Do you not see what they do in the cities of Iouda and in the ways of Ierusalem?

18 Their sons gather wood, and their fathers kindle fire, and their wives knead dough to make chauon cakes for the host of heaven, and they poured libations to foreign gods, so that they may provoke me to anger.

19 Do they provoke me to anger? says the Lord; not themselves, so that their faces may be put to shame?

20 Therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, my wrath and fury pour upon this place and upon the humans and upon the livestock and upon every tree of their field and upon all the produce of the land, and it will burn and not be extinguished.

21 Thus says the Lord, Gather your whole burnt offerings with your sacrifices and eat meat.

22 Because I did not speak to your fathers and did not command them on the day when I brought them up from the land of Egypt concerning whole burnt offerings and sacrifice;

23 but only this utterance I commanded them, saying, Hear my voice, and I will be God for you, and you will be a people for me; and go in all my ways which I command you, so that it may be well for you.

24 And they did not hear me, and their ear did not pay attention, but they went in the thoughts of their evil heart and became backward and not forward.

25 From the day when their fathers came out of the land of Egypt and until this day I also sent away to you all my slaves the prophets by day and at dawn, and I sent,

26 and they did not hear me, and their ear did not pay attention, and they hardened their neck beyond their fathers.

27-28 And you will say this word to them, This is the nation which did not hear the voice of the Lord or accept discipline; faithfulness failed from their mouth.

29 Shear your head and cast it away and take up a lament upon lips, because the Lord rejected and repudiated the generation doing these things.

30 Because the sons of Iouda did evil before me, says the Lord; they placed their abominations in the house upon which my name has been called, to defile it;

31 and they built the altar of Tapheth, which is in the ravine of the son of Ennom, to burn up their sons and their daughters in fire, which I did not command them and did not conceive in my heart.

32 Therefore behold, days come, says the Lord, and they will no longer say, Altar of Tapheth and Ravine of the Son of Ennom, but only Ravine of the Killed, and they will bury in Tapheth because there is no place.

33 And the dead of this people will be food for the birds of heaven and the beasts of the earth, and there will be no one driving them away.

34 And I will abolish from the cities of Iouda and from the passages of Ierusalem a voice of those glad and a voice of those rejoicing, a voice of a bridegroom and a voice of a bride, because all the earth will be for desolation. —

Chapter 8

1 At that time, says the Lord, they will bring out the bones of the kings of Iouda and the bones of its rulers and the bones of the priests and the bones of the prophets and the bones of those dwelling in Ierusalem from their tombs

2 and will cool them toward the sun and the moon and toward all the stars and toward all the army of heaven, which they loved and which they served and after which they went and to which they held fast and which they worshipped; they will not be lamented and will not be buried and will be for an example upon the face of the earth,

3 because they chose death rather than life, and for all the remaining ones left from that generation in every place wherever I drive them out there.

4 For thus says the Lord: Does the one falling not rise? Or does the one turning away not return?

5 Why did this people of mine turn away with a shameless turning away, and were they held fast in their choice and did not wish to return?

6 Give ear now and hear; they will not speak thus; there is no person repenting of his wickedness, saying, What have I done? The runner ceased from his course like a sweating horse in its neighing.

7 And the asida in heaven knew its time; turtledove and swallow, sparrows of the field, kept the times of their entrances, but my people did not know the judgments of the Lord.

8 How will you say, We are wise, and the law of the Lord is with us? In vain a false reed came to be for scribes.

9 Wise ones were put to shame and were terrified and were captured, because they rejected the word of the Lord; what wisdom is in them?

10 Therefore I will give their wives to others and their fields to the heirs,

13 and they will gather their produce, says the Lord; there is no grape on the vines, and there are no figs on the fig trees, and the leaves have fallen.

14 Why are we sitting? Gather together, and let us enter the fortified cities and be cast away, because God cast us away and gave us water of gall to drink, because we sinned before him.

15 We gathered for peace, and there were no good things; for a time of healing, and behold, haste.

16 From Dan we will hear the sound of the sharpness of his horses; from the sound of the neighing of the riding of his horses all the earth was shaken; and he will come and devour the earth and its fullness, a city and those dwelling in it.

17 For behold, I am sending out among you snakes that kill, which cannot be charmed, and they will bite you.

18 Incurable things with pain of your heart being at a loss.

19 Behold, a sound of the cry of the daughter of my people from a land far away: Is the Lord not in Sion? Or is there no king there? Why did they provoke me with their carved images and with foreign vanities?

20 Summer passed through, harvest passed by, and we were not saved.

21 At the crushing of the daughter of my people I was darkened; in perplexity pangs overpowered me like those of a woman giving birth.

22 Is there no resin in Galaad, or is there no physician there? Why did healing of the daughter of my people not arise?

23 Who will give water to my head and a fountain of tears to my eyes, and I will weep for this people of mine day and night, the wounded of the daughter of my people? —

Chapter 9

1 Who might give me a remotest lodging in the wilderness, and I will leave my people and go away from them? Because all commit adultery, an assembly of those breaking faith.

2 And they stretched their tongue like a bow; falsehood and not faithfulness prevailed upon the earth, because they went out from evils to evils and did not know me.

3 Each of you guard yourselves against his neighbor, and do not trust in their brothers, because every brother will trip with the heel, and every friend will walk deceitfully.

4 Each will mock his friend; they will certainly not speak truth; their tongue has learned to speak false things; they acted unjustly and did not cease to turn back.

5 Interest upon interest, deceit upon deceit; they did not wish to know me.

6 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I will refine them by fire and test them, because I will act on account of the wickedness of the daughter of my people.

7 Their tongue is a dart that wounds; the words of their mouth are deceitful; he speaks peaceful things to his neighbor and has hostility within himself.

8 Will I not visit for these things, says the Lord, or will my soul not exact vengeance on such a people?

9 Take up lamentation over the mountains and mourning over the paths of the wilderness, because they failed for lack of people; they did not hear a sound of possessions; from birds of heaven even to cattle they departed, they went away.

10 And I will give Ierusalem over to removal and to a dwelling place of dragons, and I will make the cities of Iouda a disappearance, so that they are not inhabited.

11 Who is the understanding person? And let him understand this, and the one to whom the word of the mouth of the Lord comes, let him announce to you: On account of what was the land destroyed, kindled like a wilderness, so that it is not traversed?

12 And the Lord said to me: Because they forsook my law, which I gave before their face, and did not hear my voice,

13 but went after the things pleasing to their evil heart and after the idols which their fathers taught them,

14 therefore thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I will feed them constraints and give them water of gall to drink

15 and scatter them among the nations which they and their fathers did not know, and I will send the sword after them until I consume them with it.

16 Thus says the Lord: Call the mourning women, and let them come, and send to the wise women, and let them utter a sound

17 and take up a mourning over you, and let your eyes bring down tears, and let your eyelids flow with water.

18 Because a sound of lament was heard in Sion: How we suffered misery, we were put greatly to shame, because we forsook the land and cast away our dwellings.

19 Hear now, women, a word of God, and let your ears receive words of his mouth, and teach your daughters lament, and each woman her neighbor mourning.

20 Because death went up through your windows, entered your land to wipe out infants outside and young men from the broad streets.

21 And the dead of the people will be for an example upon the face of the plain of your land and like grass behind a reaper, and there will be no one gathering.

22 Thus says the Lord: Let the wise one not boast in his wisdom, and let the strong one not boast in his strength, and let the rich one not boast in his wealth,

23 but let the one boasting boast in this: to understand and know that I am the Lord doing mercy and judgment and righteousness upon the earth, because in these is my will, says the Lord.

24 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will visit upon all those circumcised in their foreskins,

25 upon Egypt and upon Ioudaia and upon Edom and upon the sons of Ammon and upon the sons of Moab and upon everyone clipping the parts about his face, those dwelling in the wilderness; because all the nations are uncircumcised in flesh, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised in their hearts.

Chapter 10

1 Hear the word of the Lord which he spoke concerning you, house of Israel;

2 thus says the Lord: Do not learn according to the ways of the nations, and do not fear the signs of heaven, because they fear them in their faces.

3 Because the customs of the nations are vain; it is wood cut out of the forest, a carpenter's work and a casting;

4 they are adorned with silver and gold; with hammers and nails they secured them, and they will not move;

9 it is worked silver; they will not walk; applied silver will come from Tharsis, gold of Mophaz and the hand of goldsmiths, all works of craftsmen; they will clothe them in blue and purple;

5 being lifted they will be carried, because they will not step. Do not fear them, because they will certainly not do harm, and there is no good in them.

11 Thus you will say to them: Gods who did not make heaven and earth, let them perish from the earth and from beneath this heaven.

12 The Lord who made the earth in his strength, who set upright the inhabited world in his wisdom, and in his understanding stretched out heaven

13 and an abundance of water in heaven, and brought up clouds from the end of the earth, made lightning for rain and brought out light from his treasuries.

14 Every person became foolish away from knowledge; every goldsmith was put to shame over his carved images, because they cast false things; there is no spirit in them;

15 they are vain, works made a mockery of; at the time of their visitation they will perish.

16 Such is not the portion for Iakob, because he who formed all things is himself his inheritance; the Lord is his name.

17 He gathered your substance from outside, you dwelling among chosen ones.

18 Because thus says the Lord: Behold, I am tripping those dwelling in this land in affliction, so that your wound may be found;

19 woe over your crushing; your wound is painful. And I said, Truly this is my injury, and it overtook me;

20 my tent suffered misery, perished, and all my skins were torn apart; my sons and my sheep are no more; there is no longer a place for my tent, a place for my skins.

21 Because the shepherds acted foolishly and did not seek out the Lord; therefore all the pasture did not understand, and they were scattered.

22 A sound of a report, behold, is coming, and a great shaking from the land of the north, to make the cities of Iouda a disappearance and a bed of sparrows.

23 I know, Lord, that a person's way is not his own, nor will a man walk and direct his course rightly.

24 Discipline us, Lord, only with judgment and not with wrath, so that you do not make us few.

25 Pour out your wrath upon nations that do not know you and upon generations that did not call upon your name, because they devoured Iakob and consumed him and desolated his pasture.

Chapter 11

1 The word that came from the Lord to Ieremias, saying,

2 Hear the words of this covenant. And you will speak to the men of Iouda and to those dwelling in Ierusalem;

3 and you will say to them: Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Cursed is the person who will not hear the words of this covenant,

4 which I commanded your fathers on the day on which I brought them up from the land of Egypt, from the iron furnace, saying, Hear my voice and do everything that I command you, and you will be a people for me, and I will be a God for you,

5 so that I may establish my oath which I swore to your fathers, to give them a land flowing with milk and honey, as this day. And I answered and said, May it be, Lord.

6 And the Lord said to me: Read these words in the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem, saying, Hear the words of this covenant and do them.

8 And they did not do them.

9 And the Lord said to me: A conspiracy was found among the men of Iouda and among those dwelling in Ierusalem;

10 they returned to the injustices of their former fathers, who did not wish to listen to my words, and behold, they walk after foreign gods to serve them, and the house of Israel and the house of Iouda broke apart my covenant which I made with their fathers.

11 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I am bringing upon this people evils from which they will not be able to come out, and they will cry to me, and I will not listen to them.

12 And the cities of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem will go and cry to the gods to whom they burn incense; will they save them at the time of their evils?

13 Because according to the number of your cities were your gods, Iouda, and according to the number of the exits of Ierusalem you arranged altars to burn incense to Baal.

14 And you, do not pray concerning this people and do not petition for them in supplication and prayer, because I will not listen at the time at which they call upon me, at the time of their mistreatment.

15 Why did the beloved woman in my house do an abomination? Will vows and holy meats remove your wickednesses from you, or will you escape by these?

16 The Lord called your name a beautiful olive tree, well shaded in appearance; at the sound of its cutting fire was kindled upon it; great is the affliction upon you; its branches were made useless.

17 And the Lord who planted you spoke evils against you in return for the wickedness of the house of Israel and the house of Iouda, because they acted for themselves to provoke me by their burning incense to Baal.

18 Lord, make known to me, and I will know; then I saw their practices.

19 But I, like an innocent lamb being led to be sacrificed, did not know; against me they devised an evil design, saying, Come, and let us put wood into his bread and wipe him out from the land of the living, and his name will certainly not be remembered any longer.

20 Lord, judging just things, testing kidneys and hearts, may I see the vengeance from you upon them, because to you I revealed my just claim.

21 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning the men of Anathoth seeking my life, saying, You shall certainly not prophesy in the name of the Lord; otherwise you will die in our hands.

22 Behold, I will visit upon them; their young men will die by the sword, and their sons and their daughters will end in famine,

23 and there will be no remnant of them, because I will bring evils upon those dwelling in Anathoth in the year of their visitation.

Chapter 12

1 You are righteous, Lord, when I make my defense to you; nevertheless I will speak judgments to you: Why does the way of the impious prosper? Why did all those breaking faith with breaches of faith flourish?

2 You planted them, and they took root, they produced children and made fruit; you are near their mouth and far from their kidneys.

3 And you, Lord, know me; you have tested my heart before you; consecrate them for the day of their slaughter.

4 Until when will the land mourn and all the grass of the field dry up because of the wickedness of those dwelling in it? Cattle and birds disappeared, because they said, God will not see our ways.

5 Your feet run and exhaust you; how will you prepare yourself against horses? And in a land of peace you have trusted; how will you act in the raging of the Iordan?

6 Because even your brothers and the house of your father, even these rejected you, and they cried out, from behind you they gathered together; do not trust in them, because they will speak good things to you.

7 I have forsaken my house, left my inheritance, given my beloved soul into the hands of her enemies.

8 My inheritance became to me like a lion in a forest; she raised her voice against me; therefore I hated her.

9 Is my inheritance to me a hyena's cave, or a cave around her? Go, gather all the wild beasts of the field, and let them come to eat her.

10 Many shepherds destroyed my vineyard, defiled my portion, made my desirable portion an impassable wilderness;

11 it was made a disappearance of destruction; because of me all the land disappeared with disappearance, because there is no man laying it in his heart.

12 Upon every passage in the wilderness came those causing misery, because the sword of the Lord will devour from the end of the earth to the end of the earth; there is no peace for any flesh.

13 Sow wheat and reap thorns; their allotments will not benefit them; be ashamed of your boasting, of reproach before the Lord.

14 For thus says the Lord concerning all the evil neighbors who touch my inheritance which I apportioned to my people Israel: Behold, I tear them away from their land, and I will cast Iouda out from their midst.

15 And it will be after I cast them out, I will return and have mercy on them and settle them, each in his inheritance and each in his land.

16 And it will be, if learning they learn the way of my people, to swear by my name, The Lord lives, as they taught my people to swear by Baal, they also will be built up in the midst of my people;

17 but if they do not return, I will also remove that nation with removal and destruction.

Chapter 13

1 Thus says the Lord: Go and acquire for yourself a linen loincloth and put it around your waist, and it will not pass through water.

2 And I acquired the loincloth according to the word of the Lord and put it around my waist.

3 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

4 Take the loincloth around your waist and rise and go to the Euphrates and hide it there in the hole of the rock.

5 And I went and hid it at the Euphrates, as the Lord commanded me.

6 And it happened after many days, and the Lord said to me: Rise, go to the Euphrates and take from there the loincloth which I commanded you to hide there.

7 And I went to the Euphrates river and dug and took the loincloth from the place where I buried it there, and behold, it was ruined, which will certainly not be used for anything.

8 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

9 Thus says the Lord: Thus I will ruin the arrogance of Iouda and the arrogance of Ierusalem,

10 this great arrogance, those not willing to obey my words and who went after foreign gods to serve them and to worship them, and they will be like this loincloth, which will not be used for anything.

11 Because just as the loincloth clings around a person's waist, thus I caused the house of Israel and all the house of Iouda to cling to myself, to become for me a renowned people and a boast and a glory, and they did not listen to me.

12 And you will say to this people: Every skin will be filled with wine. And it will be, if they say to you, Shall we not surely know that every skin will be filled with wine?

13 And you will say to them: Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am filling those dwelling in this land and their kings, the sons of David sitting upon his throne, and the priests and the prophets and Iouda and all those dwelling in Ierusalem with drunkenness

14 and will scatter them, a man and his brother and their fathers and their sons together; I will not yearn, says the Lord, and will not spare and will not pity them so as to refrain from their destruction.

15 Hear and give ear and do not exalt yourselves, because the Lord spoke.

16 Give glory to the Lord your God before it becomes dark and before your feet stumble upon dark mountains, and you will wait for light, and there is a shadow of death, and they will be put into darkness.

17 But if you do not hear, your soul will weep secretly because of arrogance, and your eyes will bring down tears, because the flock of the Lord was crushed.

18 Say to the king and those ruling: Be humbled and sit down, because the crown of your glory was taken down from your head.

19 The cities toward the south were shut up, and there was no one opening; Ioudas was deported; he completed a complete deportation.

20 Lift up your eyes, Ierusalem, and see those coming from the north; where is the flock which was given to you, the sheep of your glory?

21 What will you say when they visit you? And you taught them lessons against yourself for rule; will not pangs hold you fast as a woman giving birth?

22 And if you say in your heart, Why did these things meet me? Because of the abundance of your injustice your hind parts were uncovered, for your heels to be exposed as an example.

23 If an Ethiopian will change his skin and a leopard her markings, you also will be able to do well, having learned evil things.

24 And I scattered them like brushwood carried by wind into a wilderness.

25 This is your lot and a portion for your disobeying me, says the Lord, because you forgot me and hoped in falsehoods.

26 And I will uncover your hind parts upon your face, and your dishonor will be seen.

27 And your adultery and your neighing and the estrangement of your prostitution, upon the hills and in the fields I have seen your abominations; woe to you, Ierusalem, because you were not cleansed after me; until when still?

Chapter 14

1 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias concerning the lack of rain:

2 Ioudaia mourned, and her gates were emptied and darkened upon the earth, and the cry of Ierusalem went up.

3 And her great ones sent their younger ones for water; they came to the wells and did not find water and brought back their vessels empty.

4 And the works of the earth failed, because there was no rain; farmers were put to shame, covered their head.

5 And deer in the field gave birth and abandoned, because there was no vegetation.

6 Wild asses stood upon wooded valleys; they drew in wind; their eyes failed, because there was no grass on account of a people of injustice. —

7 If our sins stood against us, Lord, act for us for your sake, because our sins before you are many, because we sinned against you.

8 Endurance of Israel, Lord, and you save in a time of evils; why did you become like a sojourner upon the earth and like a native turning aside into a lodging?

9 Will you be like a person sleeping or like a man unable to save? And you are among us, Lord, and your name has been called upon us; do not forget us. —

10 Thus says the Lord to this people: They loved to move their feet and did not restrain them, and God was not pleased with them; now he will remember their injustices.

11 And the Lord said to me: Do not pray concerning this people for good things;

12 because if they fast, I will not listen to their supplication, and if they offer whole burnt offerings and sacrifices, I will not be pleased with them, because by sword and by famine and by death I will bring them to an end.

13 And I said: O Lord, behold, their prophets prophesy and say, You will not see a sword, nor will famine be among you, because I will give truth and peace upon the earth and in this place.

14 And the Lord said to me: The prophets prophesy false things in my name; I did not send them and did not command them and did not speak to them; because false visions and divinations and omens and choices of their heart they themselves prophesy to you.

15 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning the prophets prophesying false things in my name, and I did not send them, who say, Sword and famine will not be upon this land: By diseased death they will die, and by famine the prophets will be brought to an end;

16 and the people to whom they prophesy, they also will be cast in the passageways of Ierusalem because of sword and famine, and there will be no one burying them, and their wives and their sons and their daughters; and I will pour their evils upon them.

17 And you will say this word to them: Bring down tears upon your eyes day and night, and let them not cease, because with crushing the daughter of my people was crushed and with an exceedingly painful wound.

18 If I go out into the plain, then behold, wounded ones of the sword, and if I enter the city, then behold, suffering of famine; because priest and prophet went to a land which they did not know. —

19 Did you utterly reject Iouda, and did your soul withdraw from Sion? Why did you strike us, and there is no healing for us? We waited for peace, and there were no good things; for a time of healing, and behold, disturbance.

20 We knew, Lord, our sins, the injustices of our fathers, because we sinned before you.

21 Cease for your name's sake; do not destroy the throne of your glory; remember, do not break apart your covenant with us.

22 Is there among the idols of the nations one making rain? And will heaven give its fullness? Are you not he? And we will wait for you, because you made all these things.

Chapter 15

1 And the Lord said to me: If Moyses and Samouel stand before my face, my soul is not toward them; send out this people, and let them go out.

2 And it will be, if they say to you, Where will we go out? You will say to them: Thus says the Lord: Those for death, to death; and those for sword, to sword; and those for famine, to famine; and those for captivity, to captivity.

3 And I will exact vengeance upon them with four kinds, says the Lord: the sword for slaughter and the dogs for tearing apart and the wild beasts of the earth and the birds of heaven for eating and for destruction.

4 And I will hand them over to constraints for all the kingdoms of the earth because of Manasse, son of Ezekias, king of Iouda, concerning all that he did in Ierusalem.

5 Who will spare you, Ierusalem? And who will be fearful over you? Or who will turn back for peace for you?

6 You turned away from me, says the Lord; you will go backward, and I will stretch out my hand and destroy you, and I will no longer let them go.

7 And I will scatter them in a scattering; at the gates of my people they were bereaved of children; they destroyed my people because of their wickednesses.

8 Their widows were multiplied beyond the sand of the sea; I brought misery upon the mother of a young man at midday; I cast upon her suddenly trembling and haste.

9 She who gave birth to seven was emptied; her soul grew faint; her sun set while the day was still at its middle; she was put to shame and reproached; their remaining ones I will give to the sword before their enemies.

10 Alas for me, mother, as what did you bear me? A man judged and disputed with by all the earth; neither did I benefit, nor did anyone benefit me; my strength failed among those cursing me.

11 May it be, Master, as they direct their course, if I did not stand by you in the time of their evils and in the time of their affliction for good things toward the enemy. —

12 Will iron be known? And a bronze covering

13 is your strength. And your treasuries I will give as plunder, an exchange for all your sins and in all your borders.

14 And I will enslave you to your enemies around you in the land which you did not know; because fire has been kindled from my wrath; upon you it will burn.

15 Lord, remember me and visit me and acquit me from those pursuing me, not unto longsuffering; know how I received reproach concerning you

16 from those rejecting your words; bring them to an end, and your word will be for me gladness and joy of my heart, because your name has been called upon me, Lord Almighty.

17 I did not sit in their assembly as they played, but was reverent before your hand; I sat alone, because I was filled with bitterness.

18 Why do those grieving me overpower me? My wound is firm; from where will I be healed? Coming to be, it became to me like false water having no faithfulness. —

19 Therefore thus says the Lord: If you return, I will also restore you, and you will stand before my face; and if you bring out what is precious from what is unworthy, you will be as my mouth; and they will turn back to you, and you will not turn back to them.

20 And I will make you for this people like a fortified bronze wall, and they will fight against you and will certainly not prevail against you, because I am with you to save you

21 and to deliver you from the hand of evil ones, and I will redeem you from the hand of pestilent ones.

Chapter 16

1 And you shall not take a wife, says the Lord, the God of Israel,

2 and no son or daughter will be born to you in this place.

3 Because thus says the Lord concerning the sons and concerning the daughters born in this place and concerning their mothers who bore them and concerning their fathers who begot them in this land:

4 By diseased death they will die; they will not be lamented and will not be buried; they will be for an example upon the face of the earth and for the wild beasts of the earth and for the birds of heaven; by sword they will fall and by famine they will be brought to an end.

5 Thus says the Lord: Do not enter their gathering and do not go to lament and do not mourn them, because I have withdrawn my peace from this people.

6 They will certainly not lament them, nor will they make incisions, and they will not shave,

7 and bread will certainly not be broken in their mourning for consolation over one who has died; they will not give him a cup to drink for consolation over his father and mother.

8 You will not enter a house of drinking to sit together with them to eat and drink.

9 For thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I am abolishing from this place before your eyes and in your days a voice of joy and a voice of gladness, a voice of bridegroom and a voice of bride.

10 And it will be, when you announce to this people all these words, and they say to you, Why did the Lord speak all these evils against us? What is our injustice? And what is our sin which we sinned before the Lord our God?

11 And you will say to them: Because your fathers forsook me, says the Lord, and went away after foreign gods and served them and worshipped them and forsook me and did not keep my law,

12 and you acted more wickedly than your fathers, and behold, you go, each after the things pleasing to your evil heart, so as not to obey me,

13 and I will cast you away from this land into the land which you and your fathers did not know, and there you will serve other gods who will not give you mercy.

14 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and they will no longer say, The Lord lives, who brought up the sons of Israel from the land of Egypt,

15 but, The Lord lives, who brought up the house of Israel from the land of the north and from all the regions where they were driven out there; and I will restore them to their land which I gave to their fathers. —

16 Behold, I am sending the many fishers, says the Lord, and they will fish for them; and after these things I will send the many hunters, and they will hunt them upon every mountain and upon every hill and out of the holes of the rocks.

17 Because my eyes are upon all their ways, and their unjust deeds were not hidden from before my eyes.

18 And I will repay their injustices and their sins double, for which they profaned my land with the carcasses of their abominations and with their lawless deeds, by which they offended against my inheritance. —

19 Lord, my strength and my help and my refuge in a day of evils, nations will come to you from the end of the earth and say, How our fathers acquired false idols, and there is no benefit in them.

20 Will a person make gods for himself? And these are not gods.

21 Therefore behold, I will show them my hand at this time and make known my power to them, and they will know that my name is the Lord.

5 Cursed is the person who has his hope in a person and will support the flesh of his arm upon him, and his heart departs from the Lord;

6 and he will be like the wild tamarisk in the wilderness; he will not see when good things come, and will dwell among salt plants and in a wilderness, in a salty land which is not inhabited.

7 And blessed is the person who has trusted in the Lord, and the Lord will be his hope;

8 and he will be like a tree flourishing beside waters and will cast its roots into moisture and will not fear when heat comes, and upon it will be leafy trunks; in a year without rain it will not fear and will not cease making fruit. —

9 The heart is deep beyond all things, and he is a person; and who will know him?

10 I am the Lord examining hearts and testing kidneys, to give each according to his ways and according to the fruits of his practices. —

11 A partridge called, gathered what she did not bear; making his wealth not with judgment, in the middle of his days they will leave him, and at his end he will be foolish.

12 A throne of glory exalted is our sanctuary,

13 endurance of Israel, Lord; let all those who left you be put to shame; let those who have departed be written upon the earth, because they forsook the fountain of life, the Lord. —

14 Heal me, Lord, and I will be healed; save me, and I will be saved; because you are my boast.

15 Behold, they say to me, Where is the word of the Lord? Let it come.

16 But I did not weary in following after you, and I did not desire a person's day; you know; the things coming out through my lips are before your face.

17 Do not become an estrangement for me, sparing me in an evil day.

18 Let those pursuing me be put to shame, and may I not be put to shame; may they be terrified, and may I not be terrified; bring an evil day upon them; crush them with a double crushing.

19 Thus says the Lord: Go and stand in the gates of the sons of your people, through which the kings of Iouda enter and through which they go out, and in all the gates of Ierusalem,

20 and you will say to them: Hear a word of the Lord, kings of Iouda and all Ioudaia and all Ierusalem, those entering through these gates;

21 thus says the Lord: Guard your souls and do not lift burdens on the day of the sabbaths and do not go out through the gates of Ierusalem

22 and do not bring out burdens from your houses on the day of the sabbaths, and you shall not do any work; sanctify the day of the sabbaths, as I commanded your fathers. And they did not hear and did not incline their ear

23 and hardened their neck beyond their fathers, so as not to hear me and not to receive discipline.

24 And it will be, if you surely hear me, says the Lord, so as not to bring burdens through the gates of this city on the day of the sabbaths and to sanctify the day of the sabbaths so as not to do any work,

25 then kings and rulers sitting upon the throne of David and riding upon their chariots and horses will enter through the gates of this city, they and their rulers, men of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem, and this city will be inhabited forever.

26 And they will come from the cities of Iouda and from around Ierusalem and from the land of Beniamin and from the plain and from the mountain and from the region toward the south, bringing whole burnt offerings and sacrifice and incense and manaa and frankincense, bringing praise into the house of the Lord.

27 And it will be, if you do not listen to me to sanctify the day of the sabbaths, so as not to lift burdens and not to enter through the gates of Ierusalem on the day of the sabbaths, I will also kindle a fire in her gates, and it will devour the quarters of Ierusalem and will not be extinguished.

Chapter 18

1 The word that came from the Lord to Ieremias, saying,

2 Rise and go down to the potter's house, and there you will hear my words.

3 And I went down to the potter's house, and behold, he was doing work upon the stones;

4 and the vessel which he was making fell apart in his hands, and again he made it another vessel, as it pleased him to make.

5 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

6 Will I not be able to make you as this potter does, house of Israel? Behold, like the potter's clay you are in my hands.

7 At a moment I will speak concerning a nation or concerning a kingdom to remove them and to destroy,

8 and that nation turns from all their evils, then I will change my mind concerning the evils which I planned to do to them;

9 and at a moment I will speak concerning a nation and concerning a kingdom to be built up and to be planted,

10 and they do evil things before me, so as not to hear my voice, then I will change my mind concerning the good things which I spoke of doing to them.

11 And now say to the men of Iouda and to those dwelling in Ierusalem: Behold, I am forming evils against you and devising a design against you; let each now turn from his evil way, and you will make your practices better.

12 And they said, We will act boldly, because we will go after our turnings away and each of us will do the things pleasing to his evil heart.

13 Therefore thus says the Lord: Ask now among nations: Who heard such dreadful things as the virgin Israel did exceedingly?

14 Will breasts cease from a rock, or snow from Libanos? Will water turn aside, carried violently by wind?

15 Because my people forgot me, burned incense in vain; and they will weaken in their ways, ancient measured courses, to step onto paths having no road for travel,

16 to make their land a disappearance and an everlasting hissing; all those passing through it will be astonished and will shake their head.

17 Like a scorching wind I will scatter them before their enemies; I will show them the day of their destruction.

18 And they said, Come, let us devise a design against Ieremias, because law will not perish from a priest and counsel from an understanding one and word from a prophet; come, and let us strike him with a tongue, and we will hear all his words. —

19 Listen to me, Lord, and listen to the voice of my just claim.

20 Are evils repaid in return for good things? Because they spoke words together against my soul and hid their punishment for me; remember my standing before your face to speak good things on their behalf, to turn your wrath away from them.

21 Therefore give their sons to famine and gather them into the hands of the sword; let their wives become childless and widows, and let their men become slain by death and their young men fallen by sword in war.

22 Let a cry arise in their houses; you will bring robbers upon them suddenly, because they undertook a plan for my capture and hid traps against me.

23 And you, Lord, knew all their counsel against me for death; do not acquit their injustices, and do not wipe out their sins from before your face; let their weakness be before you; at the time of your wrath act among them.

Chapter 19

1 Then the Lord said to me: Go and acquire a molded earthenware jar, and you will bring some of the elders of the people and some of the elders of the priests

2 and go out to the burial ground of the sons of their children, which is at the entrance of the charsith gate, and read there all the words which I speak to you,

3 and you will say to them: Hear the word of the Lord, kings of Iouda and men of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem and those entering through these gates: Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I am bringing evils upon this place, so that both ears of everyone hearing them will ring,

4 because they forsook me and estranged this place and burned incense in it to foreign gods which they and their fathers did not know, and the kings of Iouda filled this place with innocent blood

5 and built high places for Baal to burn up their sons in fire, things which I did not command or speak or think in my heart.

6 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and this place will no longer be called Falling and Burial Ground of the Son of Ennom, but rather Burial Ground of Slaughter.

7 And I will slaughter the counsel of Iouda and the counsel of Ierusalem in this place and cast them down by sword before their enemies and into the hands of those seeking their lives, and I will give their dead as food to the birds of heaven and to the wild beasts of the earth.

8 And I will make this city a disappearance and a hissing; everyone passing by it will become gloomy and hiss over all its wound.

9 And they will eat the flesh of their sons and the flesh of their daughters, and each will eat the flesh of his neighbor in the enclosure and in the siege with which their enemies will besiege them.

10 And you will crush the jar before the eyes of the men going out with you

11 and say: Thus says the Lord: Thus I will crush this people and this city, as an earthenware vessel is crushed, which will no longer be able to be healed.

12 Thus I will do, says the Lord, to this place and to those dwelling in it, to make this city like the falling one.

13 And the houses of Ierusalem and the houses of the kings of Iouda will be like the place falling with the uncleannesses in all the houses in which they burned incense upon their roofs to all the army of heaven and poured libations to foreign gods. —

14 And Ieremias came from the falling place where the Lord sent him there to prophesy, and stood in the courtyard of the house of the Lord and said to all the people:

15 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am bringing upon this city and upon all its cities and upon its villages all the evils which I spoke against it, because they hardened their neck so as not to listen to my words.

Chapter 20

1 And Paschor, son of Emmer, the priest, heard Ieremias prophesying these words, and this man was appointed leader of the house of the Lord.

2 And he struck him and put him into the confinement which was at the gate of the assigned house of the upper room, which was in the house of the Lord.

3 And Paschor brought Ieremias out of the confinement, and Ieremias said to him: The Lord did not call your name Paschor, but rather Migrant;

4 for thus says the Lord: Behold, I am giving you over to migration with all your friends, and they will fall by the sword of their enemies, and your eyes will see, and I will give you and all Iouda into the hands of the king of Babylon, and they will deport them and cut them down with swords;

5 and I will give all the strength of this city and all its labors and all the treasuries of the king of Iouda into the hands of his enemies, and they will bring them to Babylon.

6 And you and all those dwelling in your house will go into captivity, and in Babylon you will die and there you will be buried, you and all your friends to whom you prophesied false things.

7 You deceived me, Lord, and I was deceived; you prevailed and were strong; I became an object of laughter, all day I continued being mocked;

8 because with my bitter word I will be laughed at, I will call out breach of faith and misery, because the word of the Lord became a reproach to me and a mockery all my day.

9 And I said, I will certainly not name the name of the Lord and will certainly not speak any longer in his name; and it became like burning fire blazing in my bones, and I am exhausted on every side and cannot bear it.

10 Because I heard the reproach of many gathering together all around: Rise against him, and let us rise against him, all men his friends; watch his intention, whether he will be deceived and we will prevail against him and take our vengeance upon him.

11 And the Lord is with me like a strong warrior; therefore they pursued and could not understand; they were put greatly to shame, because they did not understand their dishonors, which will not be forgotten forever.

12 Lord, testing just things, understanding kidneys and hearts, may I see the vengeance from you among them, because to you I revealed my defenses. —

13 Sing to the Lord, praise him, because he delivered the soul of a poor person from the hand of those acting wickedly. —

14 Cursed is the day on which I was born; the day on which my mother bore me, let it not be wished for.

15 Cursed is the person who announced good news to my father, saying, A male was born to you, making him glad.

16 Let that person be like the cities which the Lord overturned in wrath and did not regret; let him hear a cry in the morning and a shout at midday,

17 because he did not kill me in my mother's womb, and my mother became my grave for me, and the womb one of everlasting conception.

18 Why was it that I came out of the womb to see toils and sufferings, and my days continued in shame?

Chapter 21

1 The word that came from the Lord to Ieremias when King Sedekias sent to him Paschor, son of Melchias, and Sophonias, son of Maasaias, the priest, saying,

2 Inquire of the Lord concerning us, because the king of Babylon has come against us, whether the Lord will act according to all his wonders, and he will go away from us.

3 And Ieremias said to them: Thus you will say to Sedekias, king of Iouda:

4 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am turning the weapons of war with which you fight against the Chaldeans who have enclosed you outside the wall into the middle of this city,

5 and I myself will fight you with an outstretched hand and with a mighty arm, with wrath and anger and great provocation,

6 and I will strike all those dwelling in this city, the people and the cattle, with a great death, and they will die.

7 And after these things — thus says the Lord — I will give Sedekias, king of Iouda, and his servants and the people left in this city from death and from famine and from sword into the hands of their enemies seeking their lives, and they will cut them down with the edge of the sword; I will not spare them and will certainly not pity them.

8 And to this people you will say: Thus says the Lord: Behold, I have given before your face the way of life and the way of death;

9 the one remaining in this city will die by sword and by famine, and the one going out to go over to the Chaldeans who have enclosed you will live, and his soul will be as spoils, and he will live.

10 Because I have set my face upon this city for evils and not for good things; it will be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will burn it up with fire. —

11 House of the king of Iouda, hear a word of the Lord;

12 house of David, thus says the Lord: Judge a judgment in the morning and direct rightly and deliver one plundered from the hand of the one wronging him, so that my anger is not kindled like fire and burns, and there will be no one extinguishing it.

13 Behold, I am against you dwelling in the valley of Sor, the plain, those saying, Who will terrify us? Or who will enter into our dwelling place?

14 And I will kindle a fire in her forest, and it will eat everything around her.

Chapter 22

1 Thus says the Lord: Go and descend to the house of the king of Iouda, and you will speak this word there

2 and say: Hear a word of the Lord, king of Iouda sitting upon the throne of David, you and your house and your people and those entering through these gates:

3 Thus says the Lord: Do judgment and righteousness and deliver one plundered from the hand of the one wronging him, and do not oppress a newcomer and an orphan and a widow, and do not act impiously, and do not pour out innocent blood in this place.

4 For if you surely do this word, kings sitting upon the throne of David and riding upon chariots and horses will also enter through the gates of this house, they and their servants and their people;

5 but if you do not do these words, by myself I swore, says the Lord, that this house will be for desolation.

6 Because thus says the Lord against the house of the king of Iouda: You are Galaad to me, the summit of Libanos; surely I will make you a wilderness, cities that will not be inhabited;

7 and I will bring upon you a man destroying and his axe, and they will cut down your chosen cedars and throw them into the fire.

8 And nations will pass through this city and say, each to his neighbor, Why did the Lord do thus to this great city?

9 And they will say, Because they forsook the covenant of the Lord their God and worshipped foreign gods and served them.

10 Do not weep for the dead one or mourn him; weep with weeping for the one going out, because he will not return any longer and will certainly not see the land of his homeland.

11 For thus says the Lord concerning Sellem, son of Iosias, reigning instead of Iosias his father, who went out from this place: He will not return there any longer,

12 but in the place where I deported him, there he will die and will not see this land any longer.

13 O the one building his house not with righteousness and his upper rooms not with judgment, he employs his neighbor without payment and will certainly not pay him his wage.

14 You built for yourself a well-proportioned house, airy upper rooms divided by windows and paneled in cedar and painted with vermilion.

15 Will you reign, because you are provoked with Achaz your father? They will not eat and will not drink; it was better for you to do judgment and good righteousness.

16 They did not know, did not judge a judgment for a lowly one or a judgment of a poor one; is this not your not knowing me? says the Lord.

17 Behold, your eyes are not good, nor is your heart, but toward your greed and toward innocent blood to pour it out and toward injustice and toward murder to do them.

18 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning Ioakim, son of Iosias, king of Iouda: Woe upon this man; they will certainly not lament him, O brother, nor will they weep for him, Alas, lord.

19 With an ass's burial he will be buried; dragged together, he will be thrown beyond the gate of Ierusalem.

20 Go up to Libanos and cry out, and in Basan raise your voice, and shout to the other side of the sea, because all your lovers were crushed.

21 I spoke to you in your transgression, and you said, I will not hear; this is your way from your youth; you did not hear my voice.

22 Wind will shepherd all your shepherds, and your lovers will go out into captivity; because then you will be ashamed and dishonored by all those loving you.

23 You dwelling in Libanos, nesting in the cedars, will groan when pangs come to you as to a woman giving birth.

24 I live, says the Lord; even if Iechonias, son of Ioakim, king of Iouda, should become a seal upon my right hand, from there I will tear you away

25 and hand you over into the hands of those seeking your life, before whose face you are fearful, into the hands of the Chaldeans;

26 and I will cast you and your mother who bore you into a land where you were not born, and there you will die;

27 but to the land which they long for in their souls they will certainly not return.

28 Iechonias was dishonored like a vessel for which there is no use, because he was thrown out and cast into a land which he did not know.

29 Earth, earth, hear a word of the Lord:

30 Write this man down as an outlawed person, because there will certainly not grow from his seed a man sitting upon the throne of David, ruling any longer in Iouda.

Chapter 23

1 O the shepherds scattering and destroying the sheep of my pasture.

2 Therefore thus says the Lord concerning those shepherding my people: You scattered my sheep and drove them out and did not visit them; behold, I am exacting vengeance upon you according to your evil practices;

3 and I will receive the remaining ones of my people from all the land where I drove them out there, and I will restore them to their pasture, and they will increase and multiply;

4 and I will raise up shepherds for them who will shepherd them, and they will no longer fear or be terrified, says the Lord.

5 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will raise up for David a righteous shoot, and a king will reign and understand and do judgment and righteousness upon the earth.

6 In his days Ioudas will be saved, and Israel will dwell confidently, and this is his name which the Lord will call him: Iosedek.

9 Among the prophets my heart was crushed; within me all my bones were shaken; I became like a crushed man and like a person held fast by wine, because of the face of the Lord and because of the face of the splendor of his glory.

10 Because on account of these the land mourned, the pastures of the wilderness dried up, and their course became evil and their strength not thus.

11 Because priest and prophet were defiled, and in my house I saw their wickednesses.

12 Therefore let their way become for them a slipping place in gloom, and they will be tripped and fall in it; for I will bring evils upon them in the year of their visitation, says the Lord.

13 And among the prophets of Samareia I saw lawless deeds; they prophesied through Baal and led my people Israel astray.

14 And among the prophets of Ierusalem I have seen dreadful things, committing adultery and walking in falsehoods and supporting the hands of evil ones, so that each does not turn from his evil way; they all became to me like Sodoma, and those dwelling in her like Gomorra.

15 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I will feed them pain and give them bitter water to drink, because from the prophets of Ierusalem defilement went out to all the earth.

16 Thus says the Lord Almighty: Do not hear the words of the prophets, because they make a vision vain for themselves; they speak from their heart and not from the mouth of the Lord.

17 They say to those thrusting away the word of the Lord, Peace will be for you; and to all those walking by their own wishes, to everyone walking in the error of his heart they said, Evils will not come upon you.

18 Because who stood in the council of the Lord and saw his word? Who gave ear and heard?

19 Behold, a shaking from the Lord, and anger goes out into a convulsion; whirling, it will come upon the impious.

20 And the wrath of the Lord will no longer turn back until he does it and until he raises it up from the undertaking of his heart; at the end of the days they will understand these things.

21 I was not sending the prophets, and they were running; I did not speak to them, and they were prophesying.

22 And if they had stood in my council and listened to my words, they would also have turned my people away from their evil practices.

23 I am a God drawing near, says the Lord, and not a God from far away.

24 Will a person hide in hidden places, and I will not see him? Do I not fill heaven and earth? says the Lord.

25 I heard what the prophets speak, what false things they prophesy in my name, saying, I dreamed a dream.

26 Until when will it be in the heart of the prophets prophesying false things, and in their prophesying the wishes of their heart?

27 Of those planning to forget my law in their dreams which they related, each to his neighbor, just as their fathers forgot my name through Baal.

28 The prophet in whom the dream is, let him relate his dream, and the one to whom my word comes, let him relate my word in truth. What is chaff to grain? Thus are my words, says the Lord;

29 are not my words like blazing fire, says the Lord, and like an axe cutting a rock?

30 Therefore behold, I am against the prophets, says the Lord God, those stealing my words, each from his neighbor.

31 Behold, I am against the prophets bringing forth prophecies of a tongue and dozing with their own dozing.

32 Behold, I am against the prophets prophesying false dreams, and they related them and led my people astray with their falsehoods and with their errors, and I did not send them and did not command them, and they will not benefit this people with any benefit.

33 And if this people or priest or prophet asks you, saying, What is the burden of the Lord? You will say to them, You are the burden, and I will dash you down, says the Lord.

34 And the prophet and the priest and the people who say, Burden of the Lord, I will also exact vengeance on that person and his house.

35 Because thus you will say, each to his neighbor and each to his brother: What did the Lord answer, and what did the Lord speak?

36 And do not name Burden of the Lord any longer, because his word will be the burden for the person;

37 and why did the Lord our God speak?

38 Therefore thus says the Lord God: Because you said this word, Burden of the Lord, and I sent to you, saying, You shall not say Burden of the Lord,

39 therefore behold, I am taking and dashing down you and the city which I gave to you and to your fathers,

40 and I will put upon you everlasting reproach and everlasting dishonor, which will not be forgotten.

7 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and they will no longer say, The Lord lives, who brought up the house of Israel from the land of Egypt,

8 but, The Lord lives, who gathered all the seed of Israel from the land of the north and from all the regions where he drove them out there, and restored them to their land.

Chapter 24

1 The Lord showed me two baskets of figs lying before the temple of the Lord, after Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, deported Iechonias, son of Ioakim, king of Iouda, and the rulers and the craftsmen and the prisoners and the rich from Ierusalem and brought them to Babylon;

2 one basket of very good figs, like the early figs, and the other basket of very bad figs, which will not be eaten because of their badness.

3 And the Lord said to me: What do you see, Ieremias? And I said, Figs; the good ones very good, and the bad ones very bad, which will not be eaten because of their badness.

4 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

5 Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: Like these good figs, thus I will recognize the deported ones of Iouda whom I have sent out from this place into the land of the Chaldeans for good things.

6 And I will set my eyes upon them for good things and restore them to this land for good things and build them up and will certainly not pull them down and plant them and will certainly not pluck them out;

7 and I will give them a heart for them to know me, that I am the Lord, and they will be a people for me, and I will be a God for them, because they will return to me with all their heart.

8 And like the bad figs which will not be eaten because of their badness, thus says the Lord, thus I will hand over Sedekias, king of Iouda, and his great ones and the remnant of Ierusalem, those left in this land and those dwelling in Egypt;

9 and I will give them over to scattering into all the kingdoms of the earth, and they will be for reproach and for a parable and for hatred and for a curse in every place where I drove them out there;

10 and I will send famine and death and sword among them until they cease from the land which I gave them.

Chapter 25

1 The word that came to Ieremias concerning all the people of Iouda in the fourth year of Ioakim, son of Iosias, king of Iouda,

2 which he spoke to all the people of Iouda and to those dwelling in Ierusalem, saying,

3 In the thirteenth year of Iosias, son of Amos, king of Iouda, and until this day, twenty-three years, and I spoke to you, rising early and saying,

4 and I was sending to you my servants the prophets, sending at dawn, and you did not listen and did not attend with your ears,

5 saying, Turn, each from his evil way and from your evil practices, and you will dwell upon the land which I gave to you and to your fathers from eternity and unto eternity;

6 do not go after foreign gods to serve them and to worship them, so that you do not provoke me with the works of your hands, for me to harm you.

7 And you did not hear me.

8 Therefore thus says the Lord: Since you did not believe my words,

9 behold, I am sending and will take the family from the north and bring them upon this land and upon those dwelling in it and upon all the nations around it, and I will utterly desolate them and give them over to disappearance and to hissing and to everlasting reproach;

10 and I will destroy from them a voice of joy and a voice of gladness, a voice of bridegroom and a voice of bride, a smell of myrrh and a light of a lamp.

11 And all the land will be for disappearance, and they will serve among the nations seventy years.

12 And when the seventy years are fulfilled, I will exact vengeance on that nation, says the Lord, and make them an everlasting disappearance;

13 and I will bring upon that land all my words which I spoke against it, all the things written in this book.

14 What Ieremias prophesied concerning the nations, Ailam.

15 Thus says the Lord: Let the bow of Ailam be crushed, the beginning of their dominion.

16 And I will bring upon Ailam four winds from the four ends of heaven and scatter them among all these winds, and there will be no nation where the outcasts of Ailam will not come.

17 And I will terrify them before their enemies seeking their life and bring evils upon them according to the anger of my wrath and send my sword after them until I consume them.

18 And I will set my throne in Ailam and send out from there king and great ones.

19 And it will be at the end of the days, I will turn back the captivity of Ailam, says the Lord.
—

20 At the beginning of King Sedekias reigning, this word came concerning Ailam.

2 For Egypt, concerning the force of Pharao Nechao, king of Egypt, who was at the Euphrates river in Charchamis, whom Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, struck in the fourth year of Ioakim, king of Iouda.

3 Take up weapons and shields and bring them forward into war;

4 saddle the horses; mount, horsemen, and take your stand in your helmets; put forward the spears and put on your breastplates.

5 Why are they terrified and retreating backward? Because their strong ones will be cut down. They fled with flight and did not turn back, surrounded all around, says the Lord.

6 Let the swift one not flee, and let the strong one not escape; toward the north, the things beside the Euphrates grew weak, have fallen.

7 Who is this that will rise like a river, and like rivers water surges?

8 The waters of Egypt will rise like a river, and he said, I will rise and cover land and destroy those dwelling in it.

9 Mount the horses, prepare the chariots; go out, the warriors of Ethiopians and Libyans fully armed with weapons; and Lydians, go up, stretch a bow.

10 And that day is for the Lord our God a day of vengeance to exact vengeance on his enemies, and the sword of the Lord will devour and be filled and be drunk from their blood, because there is a sacrifice for the Lord Sabaoth from the land of the north upon the Euphrates river.

11 Go up, Galaad, and take resin for the virgin daughter of Egypt; in vain you multiplied your remedies; there is no benefit for you.

12 Nations heard your voice, and the earth was filled with your cry, because warrior against warrior grew weak; together both fell.

13 What the Lord spoke by the hand of Ieremias concerning Nabouchodonosor, the king of Babylon, coming to strike the land of Egypt.

14 Announce in Magdolon and proclaim in Memphis; say, Stand ready and prepare, because a sword devoured your smilax.

15 Why did Apis flee? Your chosen calf did not remain, because the Lord disabled him.

16 And your multitude grew weak and fell, and each spoke to his neighbor: Let us rise and return to our people into our homeland from before a Greek sword.

17 Call the name of Pharao Nechao, king of Egypt, Saon — esbi — emoed.

18 I live, says the Lord God, because like Itabyrion among the mountains and like Karmel in the sea he will come.

19 Make equipment for deportation for yourself, dwelling daughter of Egypt, because Memphis will be for disappearance and will be called Woe, because there are no inhabitants in her.

20 Egypt is an adorned heifer; a detachment from the north came upon her.

21 And her hired men in her are like fattened calves fed in her, because they too turned back and fled with one accord, did not stand, because a day of destruction came upon them and a time of their vengeance.

22 A voice like a snake hissing, because they will travel in sand; with axes they will come upon her like those cutting wood.

23 They will cut down her forest, says the Lord God, because it will certainly not be estimated, because it multiplies beyond a locust, and they have no number.

24 The daughter of Egypt was put to shame, handed over into the hands of a people from the north.

25 Behold, I am exacting vengeance on Amon her son, upon Pharao and upon those trusting in him.

27 But you, do not fear, my servant Iakob, nor be terrified, Israel, because behold, I am saving you from far away and your seed from their captivity, and Iakob will return and be quiet and sleep, and there will be no one troubling him.

28 Do not fear, my servant Iakob, says the Lord, because I am with you; because I will make an end among every nation into which I drove you out there, but I will certainly not make you cease; and I will discipline you with judgment and will not acquit you as innocent.

Chapter 27

1 A word of the Lord which he spoke concerning Babylon.

2 Announce among the nations and make heard and do not hide; say, Babylon has been captured; Belos was put to shame, the fearless one; the delicate one, Marodach, was handed over.

3 Because a nation went up against her from the north; this one will make her land a disappearance, and there will be no inhabitant in her, from person even to cattle.

4 In those days and at that time the sons of Israel will come, they and the sons of Iouda together; walking and weeping they will go, seeking the Lord their God.

5 As far as Sion they will ask the way, for toward here they will turn their face; and they will come and take refuge with the Lord God, for an everlasting covenant will not be forgotten.

6 My people became lost sheep; their shepherds drove them out, led them astray onto the mountains; from mountain to hill they went, forgot their bed.

7 All those finding them consumed them; their enemies said, Let us not let them go, because they sinned against the Lord, the pasture of righteousness, who gathered their fathers.

8 Be estranged from the midst of Babylon and from the land of the Chaldeans, and go out and become like dragons before sheep.

9 Because behold, I am raising assemblies of nations against Babylon from the land of the north, and they will array themselves against her; from there she will be captured, like a dart of an understanding warrior it will not return empty.

10 And Chaldaia will be for plunder; all those plundering her will be filled.

11 Because you were glad and boasted, plundering my inheritance, because you were leaping like young cattle in vegetation and butting like bulls.

12 Your mother was put greatly to shame, a mother for good things, last of nations, a wilderness.

13 Because of the anger of the Lord she will not be inhabited and will be entirely for disappearance, and everyone traversing Babylon will become gloomy, and they will hiss over all her wound.

14 Array yourselves against Babylon all around, all those stretching a bow; shoot at her, do not spare your arrows.

15 Clap against her; her hands were disabled, her battlements fell, and her wall was razed; because it is vengeance from God, exact vengeance upon her; as she did, do to her.

16 Destroy seed from Babylon, the one holding a sickle at harvest time; from before a Greek sword each will return to his people and each will flee to his land.

17 Israel is a wandering sheep; lions drove him out; the first ate him, the king of Assour, and this one afterward his bones, the king of Babylon.

18 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I am exacting vengeance upon the king of Babylon and upon his land, as I exacted vengeance upon the king of Assour.

19 And I will restore Israel to his pasture, and he will graze in Karmel and on the mountain of Ephraim and in Galaad, and his soul will be filled.

20 In those days and at that time they will seek the injustice of Israel, and it will not exist, and the sins of Iouda, and they will certainly not be found, because I will be merciful to those left upon the earth, says the Lord.

21 Bitterly advance upon her and upon those dwelling upon her; exact vengeance, sword, and make disappear, says the Lord, and do according to everything that I command you.

22 A sound of war and great crushing in the land of the Chaldeans.

23 How was the hammer of all the earth broken together and crushed? How did Babylon become a disappearance among nations?

24 They will attack you, and you will be captured, O Babylon, and you will not know; you were found and taken, because you opposed the Lord.

25 The Lord opened his treasury and brought out the instruments of his anger, because there is work for the Lord God in the land of the Chaldeans,

26 because her times have come. Open her storehouses, search her like a cave and destroy her; let there be no remnant of her;

27 dry up all her fruits, and let them go down to slaughter; woe to them, because their day has come and the time of their vengeance.

28 A voice of those fleeing and escaping from the land of Babylon, to announce in Sion the vengeance from the Lord our God.

29 Give orders against Babylon to many, to everyone stretching a bow; encamp against her all around; let there be no one escaping from her; repay her according to her works; according to all that she did, do to her, because she opposed the Lord, the holy God of Israel.

30 Therefore her young men will fall in her broad streets, and all her men of war will be cast down, said the Lord.

31 Behold, I am against you, the arrogant woman, says the Lord, because your day has come and the time of your vengeance;

32 and your arrogance will grow weak and fall, and there will be no one raising her; and I will kindle fire in her forest, and it will devour everything around her.

33 Thus says the Lord: The sons of Israel and the sons of Iouda have been oppressed together; all those taking them captive oppressed them, because they did not wish to send them away.

34 And the one redeeming them is strong; the Lord Almighty is his name; he will judge a judgment against his adversaries, so that he may remove the earth, and he will provoke those dwelling in Babylon.

35 A sword upon the Chaldeans and upon those dwelling in Babylon and upon her great ones and upon her understanding ones;

36 a sword upon her warriors, and they will be disabled;

37 a sword upon their horses and upon their chariots; a sword upon their warriors and upon the mixed multitude in her midst, and they will be like women; a sword upon her treasuries, and they will be scattered.

38 She had trusted in her water, and they will be put to shame, because it is a land of carved images, and in the islands where they boasted.

39 Therefore phantoms will dwell in the islands, and daughters of sirens will dwell in her; she will certainly not be inhabited any longer forever.

40 As God overturned Sodoma and Gomorra and those bordering them, said the Lord, a person will certainly not dwell there, and a son of man will certainly not sojourn there.

41 Behold, a people is coming from the north, and a great nation and many kings will be raised from the end of the earth,

42 having bow and dagger; it is rash and will certainly not show mercy; their voice will resound like a sea; they will ride upon horses, prepared like fire for war against you, daughter of Babylon.

43 The king of Babylon heard the report of them, and his hands were disabled; affliction held him fast, pangs like those of a woman giving birth.

44 Behold, like a lion he will go up from the Iordan to a place of Aitham, because swiftly I will drive them away from her and set every young man over her. Because who is like me? And who will oppose me? And who is this shepherd who will stand before my face?

45 Therefore hear the counsel of the Lord which he has counseled against Babylon and his designs which he devised against the Chaldean inhabitants; surely the lambs of their sheep will be destroyed, surely pasture will disappear from them.

46 Because from the sound of the capture of Babylon the earth will be shaken, and a cry will be heard among nations.

Chapter 28

1 Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am raising against Babylon and against the Chaldean inhabitants a scorching wind destroying.

2 And I will send insolent ones into Babylon, and they will outrage her and ravage her land; woe upon Babylon all around in the day of her mistreatment.

3 Against her let the one stretching stretch his bow, and let the one who has weapons put them on, and do not spare her young men, and make all her force disappear,

4 and wounded ones will fall in the land of the Chaldeans and pierced ones outside her.

5 Because Israel and Ioudas were not widowed from their God, from the Lord Almighty; because their land was filled with injustice from the holy things of Israel.

6 Flee from the midst of Babylon, and save, each, his soul, and do not be cast away in her injustice, because it is the time of her vengeance from the Lord; he repays her a repayment.

7 Babylon is a golden cup in the hand of the Lord, making all the earth drunk; nations drank from her wine; therefore they were shaken.

8 And suddenly Babylon fell and was crushed; mourn her, take resin for her destruction, if somehow she will be healed.

9 We treated Babylon, and she was not healed; let us leave her and go away, each to his land, because her judgment reached heaven, rose up to the stars.

10 The Lord brought forth his judgment; come, and let us announce in Sion the works of the Lord our God.

11 Prepare the arrows, fill the quivers; the Lord raised the spirit of the king of the Medes, because his anger is toward Babylon to destroy her, because it is the Lord's vengeance, it is vengeance for his people.

12 Upon the walls of Babylon raise a sign, set up quivers, raise guards, prepare weapons, because the Lord undertook and will do what he spoke against those dwelling in Babylon,

13 dwelling upon many waters and upon the abundance of her treasuries; your end has come truly into your inward parts.

14 Because the Lord swore by his arm: For I will fill you with people like locusts, and those descending will raise their voice against you. —

15 Making earth in his strength, preparing the inhabited world in his wisdom, in his understanding he stretched out heaven,

16 at a voice he established a sound of water in heaven and brought up clouds from the end of the earth, made lightning for rain and brought out light from his treasuries.

17 Every person became foolish away from knowledge; every goldsmith was put to shame by his carved images, because they cast false things; there is no spirit in them;

18 they are vain, works made a mockery of; at the time of their visitation they will perish.

19 Such is not the portion for Iakob, because he who formed all things is himself his inheritance; the Lord is his name. —

20 You scatter instruments of war for me, and I will scatter nations in you and remove kings from you

21 and scatter in you horse and its rider and scatter in you chariots and their riders

22 and scatter in you young man and virgin and scatter in you man and woman

23 and scatter in you shepherd and his flock and scatter in you farmer and his cultivation and scatter in you your leaders and commanders.

24 And I will repay Babylon and all the Chaldean inhabitants all their wickednesses which they did to Sion before your eyes, says the Lord.

25 Behold, I am against you, the destroyed mountain destroying all the earth, and I will stretch out my hand upon you and roll you down from the rocks and make you like a burned mountain,

26 and they will certainly not take from you a stone for a corner and a stone for a foundation, because you will be for disappearance forever, says the Lord.

27 Raise a sign upon the earth, trumpet among nations with a trumpet, consecrate nations against her, give orders against her to the kingdoms of Ararat from me and to the Aschanazaians, set up arrow engines against her, bring up against her horses like a multitude of locusts.

28 Consecrate nations against her, the king of the Medes and of all the earth, his leaders and all his commanders.

29 The earth was shaken and suffered, because the design of the Lord rose against Babylon to make the land of Babylon a disappearance and for her not to be inhabited.

30 The warrior of Babylon ceased fighting; they will sit there in an enclosure; their dominion was shattered; they became like women; her dwellings were burned, her bars were crushed;

31 one pursuing will pursue to meet one pursuing, and one announcing to meet one announcing, to announce to the king of Babylon that his city has been captured,

32 from the end of his crossings they were taken, and their assembled structures they burned with fire, and his men of war are going out.

33 For thus says the Lord: The houses of the king of Babylon will be threshed like a ripe threshing floor; yet a little while, and her harvest will come.

34 Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, devoured me, divided me, seized me, a delicate vessel; he swallowed me like a dragon, filled his belly, drove me out from my luxury;

35 my toils and my miseries upon Babylon, she dwelling in Sion will say, and my blood upon the Chaldean inhabitants, Ierusalem will say.

36 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I will judge your adversary and exact your vengeance and desolate her sea and dry up her fountain,

37 and Babylon will be for disappearance and will not be inhabited.

38 Together they were roused like lions and like young lions.

39 In their heat I will give them a drink and make them drunk, so that they are stupefied and sleep an everlasting sleep and certainly do not rise, says the Lord;

40 I will bring them down like lambs to slaughter and like rams with kids.

41 How was the boast of all the earth captured and hunted? How did Babylon become a disappearance among the nations?

42 The sea went up over Babylon with the sound of its waves, and she was covered.

43 Her cities became a waterless and impassable land; not even one will dwell in her, nor will a son of man lodge in her.

44 And I will exact vengeance upon Babylon and bring out what she swallowed from her mouth, and the nations will certainly not gather to her any longer.

49 And in Babylon wounded ones of all the earth will fall.

50 You escaping from the land, go and do not stand; those far away, remember the Lord, and let Ierusalem come up upon your heart.

51 We were put to shame, because we heard our reproach; dishonor covered our face; foreigners entered our holy places, into the house of the Lord.

52 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will exact vengeance upon her carved images, and in all her land wounded ones will fall.

53 Because if Babylon goes up like heaven and if she fortifies the height of her strength, from me those destroying her will come, says the Lord.

54 A sound of a cry in Babylon, and great crushing in the land of the Chaldeans,

55 because the Lord destroyed Babylon and destroyed from her a great voice resounding like many waters; he gave her voice over to ruin.

56 Because misery came upon Babylon, her warriors were captured, their bow is terrified, because God repays them; the Lord repays her the repayment;

57 and he will make her leaders and her wise ones and her commanders drunk with drunkenness, says the king; the Lord Almighty is his name.

58 Thus says the Lord: The wall of Babylon was widened; being razed it will be razed, and her high gates will be burned, and peoples will not toil in vain, and nations will fail at the beginning.

59 The word which the Lord commanded Ieremias the prophet to say to Saraias, son of Nerias, son of Maasaias, when he went from Sedekias, king of Iouda, to Babylon in the fourth year of his reign, and Saraias was ruler of gifts;

60 and Ieremias wrote all the evils which will come upon Babylon in one book, all these words written concerning Babylon.

61 And Ieremias said to Saraias: When you come to Babylon, you will also see and read all these words

62 and say: Lord, Lord, you spoke against this place to destroy it and for there to be no inhabitants in it, from person to cattle, because it will be a disappearance forever.

63 And it will be, when you cease reading this book, you will also bind a stone upon it and throw it into the midst of the Euphrates

64 and say: Thus Babylon will sink and will certainly not rise because of the evils which I am bringing upon her.

Chapter 29

1 Concerning the foreigners.

2 Thus says the Lord: Behold, waters rise from the north and will become an overflowing torrent and flood land and its fullness, a city and those dwelling in it; and the people will cry, and all those dwelling in the land will shout.

3 From the sound of his rush, from the hooves of his feet and from the shaking of his chariots, the sound of his wheels, fathers did not turn back to their sons because of the failing of their hands

4 on the coming day to destroy all the foreigners; and I will make Tyre and Sidon and all the remaining ones of their help disappear, because the Lord will destroy the remaining ones of the islands.

5 Baldness has come upon Gaza; Askalon was cast away, and the remaining ones of Enakim. Until when will you cut,

6 sword of the Lord? Until when will you not be quiet? Return to your sheath, rest and be lifted up.

7 How will it be quiet? And the Lord commanded it against Askalon and against the seaside places, against the remaining ones, to rise up.

Chapter 30

1 For Idoumaia. Thus says the Lord: There is no longer wisdom in Thaiman; counsel perished from understanding ones; their wisdom went away,

2 their place was deceived. Go deep for dwelling, those dwelling in Daidan, because he did difficult things; I brought them upon him at the time at which I visited upon him.

3 Because grape gatherers came to you, they will not leave remnants for you; like thieves in the night they will lay on their hand.

4 Because I stripped Esau, uncovered their hidden things; they will certainly not be able to hide; they perished through the hand of his brother and his neighbor, and it is not possible

5 for your orphan to remain so that he may live; and I will live, and widows have trusted in me.

6 Because thus said the Lord: Those for whom it was not a law to drink the cup drank; and you, being acquitted, will certainly not be acquitted, because you will surely drink;

7 because by myself I swore, says the Lord, that you will be for an impassable place and for reproach and for a curse in her midst, and all her cities will be desolate forever.

8 I heard a report from the Lord, and he sent messengers to nations: Gather and come to her, rise for war.

9 I made you small among nations, easily despised among people.

10 Your mockery undertook against you; the rashness of your heart lodged in holes of rocks, seized the strength of a high hill; because he raised his nest like an eagle, from there I will bring you down.

11 And Idoumaia will be an impassable place; everyone passing by her will hiss.

12 Just as Sodoma and Gomorra and her neighboring places were overturned, said the Lord Almighty, a person will certainly not sit there, and a son of man will certainly not dwell there.

13 Behold, like a lion he will go up from the midst of the Iordan to a place of Aitham, because swiftly I will drive them away from her; and set the young men over her. Because who is like me? And who will oppose me? And who is this shepherd who will stand before my face?

14 Therefore hear the counsel of the Lord which he counseled against Idoumaia, and his design which he devised against those dwelling in Thaiman: Surely the least of the sheep will be dragged together, surely their lodging upon her will be made impassable;

15 because from the sound of their fall the earth was shaken, and your cry was heard in the sea.

16 Behold, like an eagle he will look and stretch his wings over her fortifications; and the heart of the strong ones of Idoumaia on that day will be like the heart of a woman in labor.

17 For the sons of Ammon. Thus said the Lord: Are there no sons in Israel, or have they no one to inherit? Why did Melchom inherit Gad, and their people will dwell in their cities?

18 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will cause a clamor of wars to be heard against Rabbath, and they will be for an impassable place and for destruction, and her altars will be burned up with fire, and Israel will inherit his rule.

19 Shout, Esebon, because Gai perished; cry out, daughters of Rabbath, gird yourselves with sackcloths and lament and mourn over Melchom, because he will go into deportation, his priests and his rulers together.

20 Why will you exult in the plains of Enakim, daughter of rashness, trusting in her treasuries, saying, Who will come against me?

21 Behold, I am bringing fear upon you, said the Lord, from all your surrounding region, and you will be scattered, each straight before him, and there will be no one gathering.

23 For Kedar, queen of the courtyard, whom Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, struck. Thus said the Lord: Rise and go up against Kedar and fill the sons of Kedem;

24 they will take their tents and their sheep; their garments and all their equipment and their camels they will take for themselves; and call destruction upon them all around.

25 Flee exceedingly, go deep for dwelling, those sitting in the courtyard, because the king of Babylon counseled counsel against you and devised a design against you.

26 Rise and go up against a stable nation sitting at rest, who have no doors, no bolts, no bars; they lodge alone.

27 And their camels will be for plunder and the multitude of their cattle for destruction; and I will winnow them with every wind, those shorn before their face; from every side of them I will bring their rout, said the Lord.

28 And the courtyard will be a dwelling of sparrows and impassable forever; a person will certainly not sit there, and a son of man will certainly not dwell there.

29 For Damascus. Emath and Arphad were put to shame, because they heard an evil report; they were astonished, became angry, will certainly not be able to rest.

30 Damascus grew faint, turned to flight; trembling seized her.

31 How did he not leave my city? They loved a village.

32 Therefore young men will fall in your broad streets, and all your men of war will fall, says the Lord;

33 and I will burn a fire in the wall of Damascus, and it will devour the quarters of the son of Ader.

Chapter 31

1 For Moab. Thus said the Lord: Woe upon Nabau, because it perished; Kariathaim was taken; Amath was put to shame and defeated.

2 There is no longer healing for Moab, a proud boast in Esebon; they devised evils against her; we cut her off from a nation, and she will surely cease; a sword will go behind you.

3 Because a voice of those crying out from Oronaim, ruin and great crushing:

4 Moab was crushed; announce in Zogora.

5 Because Alaoth was filled with weeping, he will go up weeping on the way of Oronaim; you heard a cry of crushing:

6 Flee and save your souls, and you will be like a wild ass in a wilderness.

7 Since you had trusted in your fortifications, you too will be captured; and Chamos will go out into deportation, his priests and his rulers together.

8 And ruin will come upon every city, and a city will certainly not be saved, and the valley will perish, and the plain will be destroyed, as the Lord said.

9 Give signs to Moab, because with a kindling she will be kindled, and all her cities will be for an impassable place; from where is an inhabitant for her?

10 Cursed is the one doing the works of the Lord carelessly, withdrawing his sword from blood.

11 Moab rested from childhood and was trusting in his glory; he did not pour from vessel into vessel and did not go into deportation; therefore his taste remained in him, and his smell did not cease.

12 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will send to him those tipping, and they will tip him and thin his vessels and cut together his horns.

13 And Moab will be put to shame by Chamos, just as the house of Israel was put to shame by Baithel, their hope, trusting in them.

14 How will you say, We are strong, and a person strong for warfare?

15 Moab perished, his city, and his chosen young men went down to slaughter;

16 near is the day of Moab to come, and his wickedness exceedingly swift.

17 Stir for him, all those around him, all those knowing his name; say, How was a renowned staff crushed, a rod of grandeur?

18 Come down from glory and sit in dampness, you sitting in Daibon; be wiped out, because Moab perished; one ravaging your fortification went up against you.

19 Stand upon a road and look, you sitting in Aroer, and ask one fleeing and one being saved, and say, What happened?

20 Moab was put to shame, because he was crushed; wail and cry out; announce in Arnon that Moab perished.

21 And judgment is coming into the land of Misor, upon Chailon and upon Iassa and upon Mophath

22 and upon Daibon and upon Nabau and upon the house of Deblathaim

23 and upon Kariathaim and upon the house of Gamol and upon the house of Maon

24 and upon Karioth and upon Bosor and upon all the cities of Moab, those far and those near.

25 The horn of Moab was broken, and his undertaking was crushed.

26 Make him drunk, because he magnified himself against the Lord; and Moab will strike with his hand and will himself also be an object of laughter.

27 And was Israel not a mockery to you? Was he found among your thefts, because you were fighting him?

28 Those dwelling in Moab left the cities and dwelt among rocks, became like doves nesting among rocks at the mouth of a pit.

29 I heard the arrogance of Moab; he was exceedingly arrogant; his arrogance and his haughtiness, and his heart was exalted.

30 But I knew his works; not his sufficiency, not thus did he do.

31 Therefore wail over Moab on every side, shout over the men of Kiradas of drought.

32 Like the weeping of Iazer I will weep for you, vine of Sebema; your branches crossed a sea, reached Iazer; upon your late fruit, upon your grape gatherers ruin fell.

33 Joyfulness and gladness were swept together from Moabitis, and wine was upon your winepresses; in the morning they did not tread, nor in the evening; they did not make aidad.

34 From the cry of Esebon to Eleale their cities raised their voice, from Zogor to Oronaim and Aglath — salisia, because the water of Nebrim also will be for burning.

35 And I will destroy Moab, says the Lord, going up upon an altar and burning incense to his gods.

36 Therefore my heart, Moab, will hum like pipes; my heart over the people of Kiradas will hum like a pipe; therefore what he acquired perished from a person.

37 Every head in every place they will shave, and every beard will be shaved, and all hands will be cut, and upon every waist sackcloth.

38 And upon all the roofs of Moab and upon her broad streets, because I crushed Moab, says the Lord, like a vessel for which there is no use.

39 How did he change? How did Moab turn his back? He was put to shame, and Moab became an object of laughter and resentment to all those around her.

40 Because thus said the Lord:

41 Akkarioth was taken, and the fortifications were captured;

42 and Moab will perish from a multitude, because he magnified himself against the Lord.

43 Trap and fear and pit upon you, you sitting in Moab;

44 the one fleeing from before fear will fall into the pit, and the one coming up out of the pit will be captured in the trap, because I will bring these things upon Moab in the year of her visitation.

13 All that Ieremias prophesied concerning all the nations.

15 Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: Take the cup of this unmixed wine from my hand, and you will give all the nations to drink to whom I am sending you,

16 and they will drink and vomit and go mad because of the sword which I am sending among them.

17 And I took the cup from the hand of the Lord and gave the nations to drink to whom the Lord sent me,

18 Ierusalem and the cities of Iouda and the kings of Iouda and his rulers, to make them a desolation and an impassable place and a hissing,

19 and Pharao, king of Egypt, and his servants and his great ones and all his people,

20 and all his mixed peoples and all the kings of foreigners, Askalon and Gaza and Akkaron and the remainder of Azotos,

21 and Idoumaia and Moabitis and the sons of Ammon,

22 and all the kings of Tyre and kings of Sidon and kings on the other side of the sea,

23 and Daidan and Thaiman and Ros and everything clipped about its face,

24 and all the mixed peoples lodging in the wilderness,

25 and all the kings of Ailam and all the kings of Persians,

26 and all the kings from the east, those far and those near, each with his brother, and all the kingdoms upon the face of the earth.

27 And you will say to them: Thus said the Lord Almighty: Drink and become drunk and vomit, and you will fall and certainly not rise because of the sword which I am sending among you.

28 And it will be, when they do not wish to receive the cup from your hand to drink, you will also say: Thus said the Lord: You will surely drink;

29 because in the city upon which my name was named I am beginning to do harm, and you will certainly not be cleansed with cleansing, because I am calling a sword upon those sitting upon the earth.

30 And you will prophesy these words against them and say: The Lord will pronounce from on high, from his holy place he will raise his voice; he will pronounce a word upon his place, and they will answer aidad like grape gatherers; and upon those sitting upon the earth

31 ruin has come upon a part of the earth, because the Lord has a judgment among the nations; he himself contends with all flesh, but the impious were given to a sword, says the Lord.

32 Thus said the Lord: Behold, evils come from nation to nation, and a great storm goes out from the end of the earth.

33 And there will be wounded ones by the Lord on the day of the Lord from a part of the earth even to a part of the earth; they will certainly not be buried; they will be as dung upon the face of the earth.

34 Shout, shepherds, and cry out; and lament, rams of the sheep; because your days were fulfilled for slaughter, and you will fall like the chosen rams;

35 and flight will perish from the shepherds and salvation from the rams of the sheep.

36 A sound of a cry of the shepherds and a shout of the sheep and of the rams, because the Lord destroyed their pastures,

37 and the remaining things of peace will cease because of the anger of my wrath.

38 Like a lion he left his lodging, because their land became impassable because of the great sword.

Chapter 33

1 At the beginning of King Ioakim, son of Iosias, this word came from the Lord:

2 Thus said the Lord: Stand in the courtyard of the house of the Lord and pronounce to all the Ioudaians and to all those coming to worship in the house of the Lord all the words which I ordered you to pronounce to them; do not remove a word;

3 perhaps they will hear and turn, each from his evil way, and I will cease from the evils which I am planning to do to them because of their evil practices.

4 And you will say: Thus said the Lord: If you do not hear me, to walk in my ordinances which I gave before your face,

5 to listen to the words of my servants the prophets whom I am sending to you at dawn, and I sent and you did not listen to me,

6 then I will make this house like Selom and make the city a curse for all the nations of all the earth.

7 And the priests and the false prophets and all the people heard Ieremias speaking these words in the house of the Lord.

8 And it happened, when Ieremias ceased speaking everything which the Lord ordered him to speak to all the people, the priests and the false prophets and all the people seized him, saying, By death you will die,

9 because you prophesied in the name of the Lord, saying, Like Selom this house will be, and this city will be desolated of inhabitants; and all the people assembled against Ieremias in the house of the Lord.

10 And the rulers of Iouda heard this word and went up from the king's house to the house of the Lord and sat at the entrance of the new gate of the Lord.

11 And the priests and the false prophets said to the rulers and to all the people: A judgment of death for this person, because he prophesied against this city, as you heard with your ears.

12 And Ieremias said to the rulers and to all the people, saying, The Lord sent me to prophesy concerning this house and concerning this city all these words which you heard.

13 And now make your ways and your works better and hear the voice of the Lord, and the Lord will cease from the evils which he spoke against you.

14 And behold, I am in your hands; do to me as is advantageous and as is better for you.

15 Only you will surely know that if you kill me, you put innocent blood upon yourselves and upon this city and upon those dwelling in it; because in truth the Lord has sent me to you to speak all these words into your ears.

16 And the rulers and all the people said to the priests and to the false prophets: There is no judgment of death for this person, because in the name of the Lord our God he spoke to us.

17 And men from the elders of the land rose and said to all the assembly of the people:

18 Michaias the Morathite was in the days of Ezekias, king of Iouda, and said to all the people of Iouda: Thus said the Lord: Sion will be plowed like a field, and Ierusalem will be for an impassable place and the mountain of the house for a grove of a forest.

19 Did Ezekias and all Iouda utterly kill him? Was it not that they feared the Lord and entreated the face of the Lord, and the Lord ceased from the evils which he spoke against them? And we did great evils against our souls. —

20 And there was a person prophesying in the name of the Lord, Ourias, son of Samaias, from Kariathiarim, and he prophesied concerning this land according to all the words of Ieremias.

21 And King Ioakim and all the rulers heard all his words and were seeking to kill him, and Ourias heard and entered Egypt.

22 And the king sent out men to Egypt,

23 and they brought him out from there and brought him in to the king, and he struck him with a sword and threw him into the tomb of the sons of his people.

24 Nevertheless the hand of Achikam, son of Saphan, was with Ieremias, so as not to hand him over into the hands of the people, so as not to kill him.

2 Thus said the Lord: Make bonds and collars and put them around your neck;

3 and you will send them to the king of Idoumaia and to the king of Moab and to the king of the sons of Ammon and to the king of Tyre and to the king of Sidon by the hands of their messengers coming to meet them in Ierusalem, to Sedekias, king of Iouda.

4 And you will order them to say to their lords: Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: Thus you will say to your lords,

5 that I made the earth with my great strength and with my high undertaking, and I will give it to whomever it seems good in my eyes.

6 I gave the earth to Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, to serve him, and the wild beasts of the field to work for him.

8 And the nation and the kingdom, all who do not put their neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon, by sword and by famine I will visit them, said the Lord, until they cease in his hand.

9 And you, do not hear your false prophets and those divining for you and those dreaming for you and your omens and your sorcerers saying, You will certainly not work for the king of Babylon;

10 because they prophesy false things to you to remove you far from your land.

11 And the nation which brings its neck under the yoke of the king of Babylon and works for him, I will also leave him upon his land, and he works for him and will dwell in it. —

12 And to Sedekias, king of Iouda, I spoke according to all these words, saying, Bring in your neck

14 and work for the king of Babylon, because they prophesy unjust things to you;

15 because I did not send them, says the Lord, and they prophesy in my name unjustly to destroy you, and you will perish, you and your prophets prophesying false things to you unjustly.

16 To you and to all this people and to the priests I spoke, saying, Thus said the Lord: Do not hear the words of the prophets prophesying to you, saying, Behold, vessels of the house of the Lord will return from Babylon; because they prophesy unjust things to you; I did not send them.

18 If they are prophets and if a word of the Lord is in them, let them meet me;

19 because thus said the Lord: Even of the remaining vessels,

20 which the king of Babylon did not take when he deported Iechonias from Ierusalem,

22 it will enter Babylon, says the Lord.

Chapter 35

1 And it happened in the fourth year of Sedekias, king of Iouda, in the fifth month, Ananias, son of Azor, the false prophet from Gabaon, said to me in the house of the Lord before the eyes of the priests and all the people, saying,

2 Thus said the Lord: I crushed the yoke of the king of Babylon;

3 yet two years of days, I will return to this place the vessels of the house of the Lord

4 and Iechonias and the deported people of Iouda, because I will crush the yoke of the king of Babylon.

5 And Ieremias said to Ananias before the eyes of all the people and before the eyes of the priests standing in the house of the Lord,

6 and Ieremias said, Truly; may the Lord do thus; may he establish your word which you prophesy, to return the vessels of the house of the Lord and all the deported people from Babylon to this place.

7 Nevertheless hear the word of the Lord which I speak into your ears and into the ears of all the people:

8 The prophets who came before me and before you from of old also prophesied concerning much land and concerning great kingdoms for war;

9 the prophet who prophesied for peace, when the word comes, they will know the prophet whom the Lord sent to them in faithfulness.

10 And Ananias took the collars from the neck of Ieremias before the eyes of all the people and crushed them.

11 And Ananias said before the eyes of all the people, saying, Thus said the Lord: Thus I will crush the yoke of the king of Babylon from the necks of all the nations. And Ieremias went on his way. —

12 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias after Ananias crushed the collars from his neck, saying,

13 Go and say to Ananias, saying, Thus said the Lord: You crushed wooden collars, and I will make iron collars instead of them;

14 because thus said the Lord: I put an iron yoke upon the neck of all the nations to work for the king of Babylon.

15 And Ieremias said to Ananias: The Lord has not sent you, and you made this people trust in injustice;

16 therefore thus said the Lord: Behold, I am sending you away from the face of the earth; in this year you will die.

17 And he died in the seventh month.

Chapter 36

1 And these are the words of the book which Ieremias sent from Ierusalem to the elders of the deported people and to the priests and to the false prophets, a letter to Babylon to the deported people and to all the people,

2 after King Iechonias and the queen and the eunuchs and every free person and prisoner and craftsman went out from Ierusalem,

3 by the hand of Eleasa, son of Saphan, and Gamarias, son of Chelkias, whom Sedekias, king of Iouda, sent to the king of Babylon in Babylon, saying,

4 Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel, concerning the deported people whom I deported from Ierusalem:

5 Build houses and dwell, and plant gardens and eat their fruits,

6 and take wives and produce sons and daughters and take wives for your sons and give your daughters to men, and multiply and do not be diminished,

7 and seek for the peace of the land into which I deported you there, and pray concerning them to the Lord, because in her peace there will be peace for you.

8 Because thus said the Lord: Let the false prophets among you not persuade you, and let your diviners not persuade you, and do not listen to your dreams which you dream,

9 because they prophesy unjust things to you in my name, and I did not send them.

10 Because thus said the Lord: When seventy years are about to be fulfilled for Babylon, I will visit you and establish my words upon you, to return your people to this place;

11 and I will devise a design of peace concerning you and not evils, to give you these things.

12 And pray to me, and I will listen to you;

13 and seek me out, and you will find me, because you will seek me with all your heart,

14 and I will appear to you. —

15 Because you said, The Lord appointed prophets for us in Babylon,

21 thus said the Lord concerning Achiab and concerning Sedekias: Behold, I am giving them into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will strike them before your eyes.

22 And from them they will take a curse among all the deported people of Iouda in Babylon, saying, May the Lord make you as he made Sedekias and as Achiab, whom the king of Babylon roasted in fire

23 because of the lawlessness which they did in Israel, and they committed adultery with the wives of their fellow citizens and pronounced a word in my name which I did not order them, and I am witness, says the Lord. —

24 And to Samaias the Nelamite you will say,

25 I did not send you in my name. And to Sophonias, son of Maasaias, the priest, say,

26 The Lord made you a priest instead of Iodae the priest, to become an overseer in the house of the Lord over every person prophesying and every person raving, and you will put him into the enclosure and into the confinement.

27 And now why did you revile together Ieremias from Anathoth who prophesied to you?

28 Was it not for this reason that he sent to you in Babylon, saying, It is long; build houses and dwell, and plant gardens and you will eat their fruit? —

29 And Sophonias read the book into the ears of Ieremias.

30 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias, saying,

31 Send to the deported people, saying, Thus said the Lord concerning Samaias the Nelamite: Since Samaias prophesied to you, and I did not send him, and he made you trust in unjust things,

32 therefore thus said the Lord: Behold, I will visit upon Samaias and upon his family, and there will be no person of theirs in your midst to see the good things which I will do for you; they will not see.

Chapter 37

1 The word that came to Ieremias from the Lord, to say,

2 Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel, saying, Write all the words which I pronounced to you in a book;

3 because behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will turn back the deportation of my people Israel and Iouda, said the Lord, and return them to the land which I gave to their fathers, and they will rule it.

4 And these are the words which the Lord spoke concerning Israel and Iouda:

5 Thus said the Lord: You will hear a voice of fear; fear, and there is no peace.

6 Ask and see whether a male gave birth, and concerning fear, in which they will hold fast waist and salvation; because I have seen every person and his hands upon his waist; faces turned, into jaundice

7 it became. Because that day is great, and there is none like it, and it is a narrow time for Iakob, and from this he will be saved.

8 On that day, said the Lord, I will crush the yoke from their neck and tear their bonds apart, and they do not work any longer for foreigners;

9 and they work for the Lord their God, and I will raise up David their king for them.

12 Thus said the Lord: I raised a crushing; your wound is painful;

13 there is no one judging your judgment; you were treated unto a painful thing; there is no benefit for you.

14 All your friends forgot you; they will certainly not inquire; because I struck you with an enemy's wound, a firm discipline; over all your injustice your sins multiplied.

16 Therefore all those eating you will be eaten, and all your enemies, all their flesh they will eat; over the multitude of your injustices your sins were multiplied; they did these things to you; and those plundering you will be for plunder, and all those despoiling you I will give over to spoils.

17 Because I will bring up your remedy, I will treat you for a painful wound, says the Lord, because you were called Scattered; she is your prey, because there is no one seeking her.

18 Thus said the Lord: Behold, I will turn back the deportation of Iakob and have mercy on his captivity; and a city will be built upon its height, and the temple will sit according to its judgment.

19 And from them will come out those singing and a voice of those playing; and I will multiply them, and they will certainly not be diminished.

20 And their sons will enter as formerly, and their testimonies will be set upright before my face; and I will visit those afflicting them.

21 And his stronger ones will be over them, and his ruler will come out from him; and I will gather them, and they will return to me; because who is this who gave his heart to return to me? says the Lord.

23 Because the anger of the Lord went out wrathful; whirling anger went out; it will come upon impious ones.

24 The anger of the wrath of the Lord will certainly not turn away until he does and until he establishes the undertaking of his heart; at the end of the days you will know these things.

Chapter 38

1 At that time, said the Lord, I will be a God for the family of Israel, and they will be a people for me.

2 Thus said the Lord: I found warmth in a wilderness with those perished by sword; go and do not destroy Israel.

3 The Lord appeared to him from far away: With an everlasting love I loved you; therefore I drew you into compassion.

4 Again I will build you, and you will be built, virgin Israel; again you will take your drum and go out with an assembly of those playing.

5 Again plant vineyards on the mountains of Samareia; plant and praise.

6 Because there is a day of calling of those answering on the mountains of Ephraim: Rise and go up to Sion to the Lord our God. —

7 Because thus said the Lord to Iakob: Be glad and neigh over the head of nations, make heard and praise; say, The Lord saved his people, the remnant of Israel.

8 Behold, I am bringing them from the north and will gather them from the end of the earth at the feast of phasek; and you will produce a great multitude, and they will return here.

9 With weeping they went out, and with consolation I will bring them up, lodging them beside channels of waters on a straight way, and they will certainly not stray in it; because I became a father to Israel, and Ephraim is my firstborn.

10 Hear a word of the Lord, nations, and announce to the farther islands; say, The one who winnowed Israel will gather him and guard him as one feeding his flock.

11 Because the Lord redeemed Iakob, delivered him from the hand of those firmer than he.

12 And they will come and be glad on the mountain of Sion; and they will come to the good things of the Lord, to a land of grain and wine and fruits and cattle and sheep, and their soul will be like a fruitful tree, and they will hunger no longer.

13 Then virgins will rejoice in an assembly of young men, and old men will rejoice, and I will turn their mourning into joy and make them glad.

14 I will magnify and make drunk the soul of the priests, sons of Leui, and my people will be filled with my good things.

15 Thus said the Lord: A voice was heard in Rama of mourning and weeping and lament; Rachel weeping did not wish to cease over her sons, because they are no more.

16 Thus said the Lord: Let your voice cease from weeping and your eyes from your tears, because there is a wage for your works, and they will return from a land of enemies,

17 a lasting thing for your children.

18 I surely heard Ephraim lamenting: You disciplined me, and I was disciplined; like a calf I was not taught; turn me, and I will return, because you are the Lord my God.

19 Because after my captivity I repented, and after I came to know I groaned over days of shame and showed you that I received reproach from my youth.

20 Ephraim is a beloved son to me, a child delighting, because since my words are in him, I will surely remember him; therefore I hastened over him; I will surely have mercy on him, says the Lord.

21 Set yourself up, Sion, make retribution, set your heart upon the shoulders; turn back along the way which you traveled, virgin Israel; turn back to your cities, mourning.

22 Until when will you turn away, dishonored daughter? Because the Lord created salvation for a new planting; in salvation people will go about.

23 Thus said the Lord: Again they will say this word in the land of Iouda and in his cities when I turn back his captivity: Blessed is the Lord upon a righteous mountain, his holy one,

24 and those dwelling in the cities of Iouda and in all his land together with a farmer, and he will be lifted up among a flock.

25 Because I made every thirsty soul drunk and filled every hungry soul.

26 Therefore I awoke and saw, and my sleep became sweet to me.

27 Therefore behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will sow Israel and Iouda with seed of person and seed of cattle.

28 And it will be, as I was watching over them to pull down and to harm, thus I will watch over them to build and plant, says the Lord.

29 In those days they will certainly not say, The fathers ate an unripe grape, and the teeth of the children were set on edge;

30 but each will die in his own sin, and the teeth of the one eating the unripe grape will be set on edge.

31 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will make a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Iouda,

32 not according to the covenant which I made with their fathers on the day when I took hold of their hand to bring them out from the land of Egypt, because they did not remain in my covenant, and I disregarded them, says the Lord;

33 because this is the covenant which I will make with the house of Israel after those days, says the Lord: I will surely give my laws into their understanding and write them upon their hearts; and I will be a God for them, and they will be a people for me;

34 and they will certainly not teach, each his fellow citizen and each his brother, saying, Know the Lord; because all will know me, from their small one even to their great one, because I will be merciful to their injustices and will certainly not remember their sins any longer. —

35 If heaven is raised into the heights, says the Lord, and if the foundation of the earth is lowered below, I also will not reject the family of Israel, says the Lord, concerning all that they did.

36 Thus said the Lord, who gave the sun for light of the day, moon and stars for light of the night, and a cry in the sea, and its waves roared; the Lord Almighty is his name:

37 If these laws cease from before my face, says the Lord, the family of Israel will also cease to be a nation before my face all the days. —

38 Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and a city will be built for the Lord from the tower of Anameel to the corner gate;

39 and its measurement will go out opposite them as far as the hills of Gareb, and it will be surrounded all around with chosen stones;

40 and all asaremoth as far as nachal Kedron, as far as the corner of the horse gate of the east, a sanctuary for the Lord, and it will certainly not cease any longer and will certainly not be pulled down forever.

Chapter 39

1 The word that came from the Lord to Ieremias in the tenth year for King Sedekias; this is the eighteenth year for King Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon,

2 and the force of the king of Babylon made a siegework against Ierusalem, and Ieremias was guarded in the courtyard of the prison which is in the king's house,

3 in which King Sedekias shut him up, saying, Why do you prophesy, saying, Thus said the Lord: Behold, I am giving this city into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will take it,

4 and Sedekias will certainly not be saved from the hand of the Chaldeans, because he will surely be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon, and his mouth will speak to his mouth, and his eyes will see his eyes,

5 and Sedekias will enter Babylon and sit there.

6 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias, saying,

7 Behold, Anameel, son of Salom, your father's brother, is coming to you, saying, Acquire for yourself my field in Anathoth, because yours is the right to receive it as a possession.

8 And Anameel, son of Salom, my father's brother, came to me in the courtyard of the prison and said to me, Acquire my field in the land of Beniamin, in Anathoth, because yours is the right to acquire, and you are the elder. And I knew that it is a word of the Lord,

9 and I acquired the field of Anameel, son of my father's brother, and weighed out for him seven shekels and ten of silver;

10 and I wrote in a book and sealed it and called witnesses to testify and weighed the silver in a balance.

11 And I took the book of the acquisition, the sealed one and the read one,

12 and gave it to Barouch, son of Nerias, son of Maasaias, before the eyes of Anameel, son of my father's brother, and before the eyes of those standing and writing in the book of the acquisition and before the eyes of the Ioudaians in the courtyard of the prison.

13 And I ordered Barouch before their eyes, saying,

14 Thus said the Lord Almighty: Take this book of the acquisition and the read book, and you will put it into an earthenware vessel, so that it remains many days.

15 Because thus said the Lord: Again fields and houses and vineyards will be acquired in this land.

16 And I prayed to the Lord after I gave the book of the acquisition to Barouch, son of Nerias, saying,

17 O Lord, you made heaven and earth by your great strength and by your high and lofty arm; nothing will certainly be hidden from you,

18 doing mercy unto thousands and repaying sins of fathers into the bosoms of their children after them, the great and strong God,

19 Lord of great counsel and powerful in works, the great God, the Almighty and the Lord of a great name; your eyes are upon the ways of the sons of people, to give each according to his way;

20 you who made signs and wonders in the land of Egypt until this day and in Israel and among those born of earth, and made yourself a name as this day,

21 and brought out your people Israel from the land of Egypt with signs and with wonders and with a mighty hand and with a high arm and with great visions,

22 and gave them this land which you swore to their fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey;

23 and they entered and took it and did not hear your voice and did not walk in your ordinances; all that you commanded them they did not do; and you made all these evils happen to them.

24 Behold, a multitude has come into this city to capture it, and the city was given into the hands of the Chaldeans fighting it because of sword and famine; as you spoke, thus it happened.

25 And you say to me, Acquire for yourself a field for silver; and I wrote a book and sealed it and called witnesses to testify; and the city was given into the hands of the Chaldeans.

26 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

27 I am the Lord, the God of all flesh; will anything be hidden from me?

28 Therefore thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: Being given, this city will be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will take it,

29 and the Chaldeans fighting will come against this city and burn this city with fire and burn up the houses in which they were burning incense upon their roofs to Baal and pouring libations to other gods to embitter me.

30 Because the sons of Israel and the sons of Iouda alone were doing evil before my eyes from their youth;

31 because this city was for my anger and for my wrath from the day on which they built it and until this day, to remove it from before my face

32 because of all the wickednesses of the sons of Israel and Iouda which they did to embitter me, they and their kings and their rulers and their priests and their prophets, men of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem,

33 and they turned a back to me and not a face, and I taught them at dawn and taught, and they did not hear to receive discipline;

34 and they placed their defilements in the house upon which my name was called, in their uncleannesses,

35 and built the altars to Baal in the ravine of the son of Ennom to offer up their sons and their daughters to Moloch the king, things which I did not order them and which did not come up upon my heart, to do this abomination so that Iouda should sin. —

36 And now thus said the Lord, the God of Israel, concerning the city of which you say, It will be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon by sword and by famine and by sending away:

37 Behold, I am gathering them from all the land where I scattered them there in my anger and my wrath and great provocation, and I will return them to this place and settle them confidently,

38 and they will be a people for me, and I will be a God for them.

39 And I will give them another way and another heart to fear me all the days, for good for them and for their children after them.

40 And I will make an everlasting covenant with them which I will certainly not turn back behind them; and I will put my fear into their heart so that they do not depart from me.

41 And I will visit to do good to them and plant them in this land in faithfulness and with all heart and with all soul.

42 Because thus said the Lord: As I brought all these great evils upon this people, thus I will bring upon them all the good things which I spoke concerning them.

43 And again fields will be acquired in the land of which you say, It is impassable, without people and cattle, and they were handed over into the hands of the Chaldeans.

44 And they will acquire fields with silver, and you will write a book and seal it and call witnesses to testify in the land of Beniamin and around Ierusalem and in the cities of Iouda and in the cities of the mountain and in the cities of Sephela and in the cities of Nageb, because I will turn back their deportations.

Chapter 40

1 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias a second time, and he was still bound in the courtyard of the prison, saying,

2 Thus said the Lord, making earth and forming it to set it upright; the Lord is his name:

3 Cry to me, and I will answer you and report to you great and strong things which you did not know.

4 Because thus said the Lord, the God of Israel, concerning the houses of this city and concerning the houses of the king of Iouda pulled down for siegeworks and ramparts,

5 to fight against the Chaldeans and fill it with the dead of the people whom I struck in my anger and in my wrath, and I turned my face away from them concerning all their wickednesses:

6 Behold, I am bringing up for her closing of wounds and a remedy and will reveal to them to listen, and I will treat her and make peace and faithfulness for them;

7 and I will return the deported people of Iouda and the deported people of Israel and build them as formerly;

8 and I will cleanse them from all their injustices which they sinned against me, and I will certainly not remember their sins which they sinned against me and departed from me.

9 And it will be for gladness and for praise and for greatness for all the people of the earth, who will hear all the good things which I will do, and they will fear and be embittered concerning all the good things and concerning all the peace which I will make for them. —

10 Thus said the Lord: Again there will be heard in this place of which you say, It is desolate, without people and cattle, in the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem, the desolated places for lack of person and cattle,

11 a voice of gladness and a voice of joyfulness, a voice of bridegroom and a voice of bride, a voice of those saying, Give thanks to the Lord Almighty, because the Lord is good, because his mercy is forever; and they will bring gifts into the house of the Lord; because I will turn back all the deportation of that land as formerly, said the Lord.

12 Thus said the Lord of the forces: Again there will be in this place desolate for lack of person and cattle and in all its cities lodgings of shepherds laying sheep down;

13 in the cities of the hill country and in the cities of Sephela and in the cities of Nageb and in the land of Beniamin and in those around Ierusalem and in the cities of Iouda again sheep will pass under the hand of one counting, said the Lord.

Chapter 41

1 The word that came to Ieremias from the Lord, and Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, and all his army and all the land of his rule were fighting against Ierusalem and against all the cities of Iouda, saying,

2 Thus said the Lord: Go to Sedekias, king of Iouda, and you will say to him: Thus said the Lord: This city will surely be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he will capture it and burn it with fire;

3 and you will certainly not be saved from his hand, and you will surely be captured and be given into his hands, and your eyes will see his eyes, and his mouth will speak with your mouth, and you will enter Babylon.

4 But hear the word of the Lord, Sedekias, king of Iouda: Thus says the Lord:

5 In peace you will die, and as they wept for your fathers who reigned before you, they will weep for you also, and, O adon, they will lament you; because I spoke a word, said the Lord.

6 And Ieremias spoke all these words to King Sedekias in Ierusalem;

7 and the force of the king of Babylon was fighting against Ierusalem and against the cities of Iouda, against Lachis and against Azeka, because these were left among the cities of Iouda as fortified cities.

8 The word that came to Ieremias from the Lord after King Sedekias completed a covenant with the people to proclaim release,

9 for each to send out his male servant and each his female servant, the Hebrew man and the Hebrew woman, free, so that a man from Iouda should not be enslaved,

10 and all the great ones and all the people who entered into the covenant to send away, each, his male servant and, each, his female servant turned back

11 and put them as male servants and female servants.

12 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias, saying,

13 Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: I made a covenant with your fathers on the day on which I delivered them from the land of Egypt, from a house of slavery, saying,

14 When six years are fulfilled, you will send away your Hebrew brother who will be sold to you; and he works for you six years, and you will send him out free. And they did not hear me and did not incline their ear.

15 And today they returned to do what is straight before my eyes, to proclaim release, each of his neighbor, and completed a covenant before my face in the house upon which my name was called.

16 And you turned back and profaned my name by bringing back, each, his male servant and, each, his female servant whom you sent out free according to their soul, as male servants and female servants for you.

17 Therefore thus said the Lord: You did not hear me to proclaim release, each to his neighbor; behold, I proclaim release for you to sword and to death and to famine, and I will give you over to scattering for all the kingdoms of the earth.

18 And I will give the men who transgressed my covenant, who did not establish my covenant which they made before my face, the calf which they made to work for him,

19 the rulers of Iouda and the powerful ones and the priests and the people,

20 and I will give them to their enemies, and their carcasses will be food for the birds of heaven and for the wild beasts of the earth.

21 And Sedekias, king of Ioudaia, and their rulers I will give into the hands of their enemies, and the force of the king of Babylon, to those running away from them.

22 Behold, I am ordering, says the Lord, and I will return them to this land, and they will fight against it and take it and burn it up with fire, and the cities of Iouda, and I will make them desolate of inhabitants.

Chapter 42

1 The word that came to Ieremias from the Lord in the days of Ioakim, king of Iouda, saying,

2 Go to the house of Archabin and bring them into the house of the Lord into one of the courtyards, and you will give them wine to drink.

3 And I brought out Iezonias, son of Ieremin, son of Chabasin, and his brothers and his sons and all the household of Archabin

4 and brought them into the house of the Lord into the chamber of the sons of Ananias, son of Godolias, a man of God, which is near the house of the rulers above the house of Maasaias, son of Selom, guarding the courtyard,

5 and set before their face a jar of wine and cups and said, Drink wine.

6 And they said, We will certainly not drink wine, because Ionadab, son of Rechab, our father, commanded us, saying, You shall certainly not drink wine, you and your sons forever,

7 and you shall certainly not build a house and certainly not sow seed, and you will have no vineyard, because in tents you will dwell all your days, so that you may live many days upon the land upon which you stay.

8 And we heard the voice of Ionadab our father so as not to drink wine all our days, we and our wives and our sons and our daughters,

9 and so as not to build houses to dwell there, and vineyard and field and seed did not come to be for us,

10 and we dwelt in tents and heard and did according to everything which Ionadab our father commanded us.

11 And it happened, when Nabouchodonosor went up against the land, we also said, Enter, and let us enter Ierusalem from before the force of the Chaldeans and from before the force of the Assyrians, and we dwelt there. —

12 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

13 Thus says the Lord: Go and say to a person of Iouda and to those dwelling in Ierusalem: Will you not receive discipline to hear my words?

14 The sons of Ionadab, son of Rechab, established the word which he commanded his children so as not to drink wine, and they did not drink; and I spoke to you at dawn and spoke, and you did not hear.

15 And I sent to you my servants the prophets, saying, Turn, each from his evil way, and make your practices better, and you will not go after other gods to serve them, and you will dwell upon the land which I gave to you and to your fathers; and you did not incline your ears and did not hear.

16 And the sons of Ionadab, son of Rechab, established the commandment of their father, but this people did not hear me.

17 Therefore thus said the Lord: Behold, I am bringing upon Iouda and upon those dwelling in Ierusalem all the evils which I spoke against them.

18 Therefore thus said the Lord: Since the sons of Ionadab, son of Rechab, heard the commandment of their father to do as their father commanded them,

19 a man of the sons of Ionadab, son of Rechab, standing before my face will certainly not cease all the days of the earth.

Chapter 43

1 And in the fourth year of Ioakim, son of Iosias, king of Iouda, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Take for yourself a book roll and write upon it all the words which I pronounced to you concerning Ierusalem and concerning Iouda and concerning all the nations from the day of my speaking to you, from the days of Iosias, king of Iouda, and until this day;

3 perhaps the house of Iouda will hear all the evils which I am planning to do to them, so that they turn from their evil way, and I will be merciful to their injustices and their sins. —

4 And Ieremias called Barouch, son of Nerias, and he wrote from the mouth of Ieremias all the words of the Lord which he pronounced to him in a book roll.

5 And Ieremias commanded Barouch, saying, I am guarded; I certainly cannot enter the house of the Lord;

6 and you will read in this roll into the ears of the people in the house of the Lord on a day of fasting, and in the ears of all Iouda coming from their city you will read to them;

7 perhaps their plea for mercy will fall before the face of the Lord, and they will turn from their evil way, because great is the wrath and anger of the Lord which he spoke against this people.

8 And Barouch did according to everything which Ieremias commanded him, to read in the book words of the Lord in the house of the Lord. —

9 And it happened in the eighth year for King Ioakim, in the ninth month, all the people in Ierusalem and the house of Iouda assembled for a fast before the face of the Lord.

10 And Barouch was reading in the book the words of Ieremias in the house of the Lord, in the house of Gamarias, son of Saphan, the scribe, in the upper courtyard, at the entrance of the new gate of the house of the Lord, in the ears of all the people. —

11 And Michaias, son of Gamarias, son of Saphan, heard all the words of the Lord from the book;

12 and he went down to the king's house, to the house of the scribe, and behold, there all the rulers were sitting, Elisama the scribe and Dalaias, son of Selemias, and Elnathan, son of Akchobor, and Gamarias, son of Saphan, and Sedekias, son of Ananias, and all the rulers,

13 and Michaias announced to them all the words which he heard Barouch reading into the ears of the people.

14 And all the rulers sent to Barouch, son of Nerias, Ioudin, son of Nathanias, son of Selemias, son of Chousi, saying, The roll in which you read in the ears of the people, take it into your hand and come; and Barouch took the roll and went down to them.

15 And they said to him, Again read into our ears; and Barouch read.

16 And it happened, when they heard all the words, they counseled together, each with his neighbor, and said, Let us surely announce to the king all these words.

17 And they asked Barouch, saying, From where did you write all these words?

18 And Barouch said, From his mouth Ieremias announced all these words to me, and I was writing in a book.

19 And they said to Barouch, Go, hide, you and Ieremias; let no person know where you are.

20 And they entered to the king in the courtyard, and gave the roll to be guarded in the house of Elisama, and announced to the king all the words. —

21 And the king sent Ioudin to take the roll, and he took it from the house of Elisama; and Ioudin read into the ears of the king and into the ears of all the rulers standing around the king.

22 And the king was sitting in a winter house, and a hearth of fire was before his face.

23 And it happened, as Ioudin read three pages and four, he cut them off with the scribe's razor and threw them into the fire upon the hearth, until all the roll was consumed in the fire upon the hearth.

24 And they did not seek and did not tear their garments, the king and his servants hearing all these words;

25 and Elnathan and Godolias and Gamarias urged the king not to burn up the roll.

26 And the king commanded Ieremeel, son of the king, and Saraias, son of Esriel, to seize Barouch and Ieremias; and they were hidden.

27 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias after the king burned up the roll, all the words which Barouch wrote from the mouth of Ieremias, saying,

28 Again take another roll and write all the words that were upon the roll which King Ioakim burned up.

29 And you will say: Thus said the Lord: You burned up this roll, saying, Why did you write upon it, saying, The king of Babylon will surely enter and destroy this land, and person and cattle will cease from it?

30 Therefore thus said the Lord concerning Ioakim, king of Iouda: He will have no one sitting upon the throne of David, and his carcass will be cast in the heat of the day and in the frost of the night;

31 and I will visit upon him and upon his family and upon his servants and bring upon them and upon those dwelling in Ierusalem and upon the land of Iouda all the evils which I spoke to them, and they did not hear.

32 And Barouch took another roll and wrote upon it from the mouth of Ieremias all the words of the book which Ioakim burned up; and still more words like these were added to it.

Chapter 44

1 And Sedekias, son of Iosias, reigned instead of Ioakim, whom Nabouchodonosor made king to reign over Iouda;

2 and he and his servants and the people of the land did not hear the words of the Lord which he spoke by the hand of Ieremias. —

3 And King Sedekias sent Ioachal, son of Selemias, and Sophonias, son of Maasaias, the priest, to Ieremias, saying, Pray now concerning us to the Lord.

4 And Ieremias came and passed through the midst of the city, and they did not put him into a house of the prison.

5 And Pharao's force went out from Egypt, and the Chaldeans heard the report of them and withdrew from Ierusalem.

6 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias, saying,

7 Thus said the Lord: Thus you will say to the king of Iouda who sent to you to seek me out: Behold, Pharao's force that came out to help you will return to the land of Egypt,

8 and the Chaldeans themselves will return and fight against this city and capture it and burn it with fire.

9 Because thus said the Lord: Do not suppose in your souls, saying, The Chaldeans will surely run away from us, because they will certainly not go away;

10 and if you strike all the force of the Chaldeans fighting you, and some pierced ones are left, each in his place, these will rise and burn this city with fire.

11 And it happened, when the force of the Chaldeans withdrew from Ierusalem before Pharao's force,

12 Ieremias went out from Ierusalem to go to the land of Beniamin to buy from there in the midst of the people.

13 And he came to be at the gate of Beniamin, and there was a person with whom he lodged, Sarouias, son of Selemias, son of Ananias, and he seized Ieremias, saying, You are fleeing to the Chaldeans.

14 And he said, Falsehood; I am not fleeing to the Chaldeans. And he did not hear him, and Sarouias seized Ieremias and brought him to the rulers.

15 And the rulers were embittered against Ieremias and struck him and sent him to the house of Ionathan the scribe, because they made this a prison house.

16 And Ieremias came into the house of the pit and into the chereth and sat there many days.

17 And Sedekias sent and called him, and the king asked him secretly to say whether there is a word from the Lord, and he said, There is; you will be handed over into the hands of the king of Babylon.

18 And Ieremias said to the king: What wrong did I do to you and your servants and this people, that you put me into a prison house?

19 And where are your prophets who prophesied to you, saying that the king of Babylon will certainly not come upon this land?

20 And now, lord king, let my plea for mercy fall before your face, and why do you return me to the house of Ionathan the scribe, and shall I certainly not die there?

21 And the king ordered, and they put him into a house of the prison and gave him one loaf a day from outside where they bake, until the loaves ceased from the city; and Ieremias sat in the courtyard of the prison.

Chapter 45

1 And Saphatias, son of Mathan, and Godolias, son of Paschor, and Ioachal, son of Selemias, heard the words which Ieremias was speaking to the people, saying,

2 Thus said the Lord: The one dwelling in this city will die by sword and by famine, and the one going out to the Chaldeans will live, and his soul will be as a find, and he will live;

3 because thus said the Lord: Being handed over, this city will be handed over into the hands of the force of the king of Babylon, and he will capture it.

4 And they said to the king: Let that person now be killed, because he weakens the hands of the people fighting who remain in the city and the hands of all the people, speaking to them according to these words, because this person does not pronounce peace for this people but rather evil things.

5 And the king said, Behold, he is in your hands; because the king could not prevail against them.

6 And they threw him into the pit of Melchias, son of the king, which was in the courtyard of the prison, and lowered him into the pit, and in the pit there was no water but rather mud, and he was in the mud.

7 And Abdemelech the Ethiopian heard, and he was in the king's house, that they put Ieremias into the pit; and the king was at the gate of Beniamin;

8 and he went out to him and spoke to the king and said,

9 You acted wickedly in what you did, to kill this person because of famine, because there are no longer loaves in the city.

10 And the king commanded Abdemelech, saying, Take into your hands from here thirty people and bring him up out of the pit, so that he does not die.

11 And Abdemelech took the people and entered the underground house of the king and took from there old rags and old ropes and threw them to Ieremias into the pit

12 and said, Put these beneath the ropes; and Ieremias did thus.

13 And they drew him with the ropes and brought him up out of the pit; and Ieremias sat in the courtyard of the prison.

14 And the king sent and called him to himself into the aselisi house in the house of the Lord; and the king said to him, I will ask you a word, and do not now hide a word from me.

15 And Ieremias said to the king: If I announce to you, will you not surely put me to death? And if I counsel you, you will certainly not hear me.

16 And the king swore to him, saying, The Lord lives, who made this soul for us; surely I will not kill you and will not give you into the hands of these people.

17 And Ieremias said to him: Thus said the Lord: If you surely go out to the leaders of the king of Babylon, your soul will also live, and this city will certainly not be burned up with fire, and you will live, you and your household;

18 and if you do not go out, this city will be given into the hands of the Chaldeans, and they will burn it with fire, and you will certainly not be saved.

19 And the king said to Ieremias: I have concern about the Ioudaians who have fled to the Chaldeans, lest they give me into their hands, and they will mock me.

20 And Ieremias said: They will certainly not hand you over; hear the word of the Lord which I speak to you, and it will be better for you, and your soul will live.

21 And if you do not wish to go out, this is the word which the Lord showed me:

22 And behold, all the women left in the house of the king of Iouda were being brought out to the rulers of the king of Babylon, and these were saying, Your men of peace deceived you and will prevail against you and lodge your feet in slipping places; they turned away from you.

23 And they will bring out your wives and your children to the Chaldeans, and you will certainly not be saved, because you will be captured in the hand of the king of Babylon, and this city will be burned up.

24 And the king said to him: Let no person know of these words, and you will certainly not die.

25 And if the rulers hear that I spoke to you and come to you and say to you, Announce to us what the king spoke to you; do not hide from us, and we will certainly not kill you; and what did the king speak to you?

26 You will also say to them, I cast my plea for mercy before the eyes of the king, so as not to return me to the house of Ionathan to die there.

27 And all the rulers came to Ieremias and asked him, and he announced to them according to all these words which the king commanded him; and they kept silent, because a word of the Lord was not heard.

28 And Ieremias sat in the courtyard of the prison until the time when Ierusalem was captured.

Chapter 46

1 And it happened in the ninth year of Sedekias, king of Iouda, in the tenth month, Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, and all his force came against Ierusalem and were besieging her.

2 And in the eleventh year of Sedekias, in the fourth month, on the ninth of the month, the city was breached.

3 And all the leaders of the king of Babylon entered and sat in the middle gate, Nargalasar and Samagoth and Nabousachar and Nabousaris and Nagargasnaser Rabamag and the remaining leaders of the king of Babylon;

14 and they sent and took Ieremias from the courtyard of the prison and gave him to Godolias, son of Achikam, son of Saphan; and they brought him out, and he sat in the midst of the people.

15 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias in the courtyard of the prison, saying,

16 Go and say to Abdemelech the Ethiopian: Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: Behold, I am bringing my words upon this city for evils and not for good things;

17 and I will save you on that day and will certainly not give you into the hands of the people before whose face you fear.

18 Because I will surely save you, and you will certainly not fall by sword; and your soul will be as a find, because you had trusted in me, says the Lord.

Chapter 47

1 The word that came from the Lord to Ieremias afterward, after Nabouzardan the chief cook sent him away from Daman, when he took him in handcuffs in the midst of the deported people of Iouda being brought to Babylon.

2 And the chief cook took him and said to him: The Lord your God spoke these evils against this place,

3 and the Lord did them, because you sinned against him and did not hear his voice.

4 Behold, I released you from the handcuffs upon your hands; if it is good before you to come with me to Babylon, come, and I will set my eyes upon you;

5 but if not, go away and return to Godolias, son of Achikam, son of Saphan, whom the king of Babylon appointed in the land of Iouda, and dwell with him in the midst of the people in the land of Iouda; to all that is good in your eyes to go to, go. And the chief cook gave him gifts and sent him away.

6 And he came to Godolias in Massepha and sat in the midst of the people left in the land.

7 And all the leaders of the force in the field heard, they and their men, that the king of Babylon appointed Godolias in the land and entrusted to him men and their wives whom he did not deport to Babylon.

8 And Ismael, son of Nathanias, and Ioanan, son of Karee, and Saraias, son of Thanaemeth, and the sons of Ophe the Netophati and Iezonias, son of the Mochati, came to Godolias in Massepha, they and their men.

9 And Godolias swore to them and to their men, saying, Do not fear before the servants of the Chaldeans; dwell in the land and work for the king of Babylon, and it will be better for you;

10 and behold, I sit before you in Massepha to stand before the face of the Chaldeans who come upon you, and you, gather wine and late fruit and gather oil and put them into your vessels and dwell in the cities which you held fast.

11 And all the Ioudaians in the land of Moab and among the sons of Ammon and those in Idoumaia and those in all the land heard that the king of Babylon gave a remnant to Iouda and that he appointed over them Godolias, son of Achikam,

12 and they came to Godolias in the land of Iouda in Massepha and gathered wine and exceedingly much late fruit and oil.

13 And Ioanan, son of Karee, and all the leaders of the force in the fields came to Godolias in Massepha

14 and said to him: Do you surely know that Belisa, king of the sons of Ammon, sent Ismael to you to strike your soul? And Godolias did not believe them.

15 And Ioanan said to Godolias secretly in Massepha: Let me now go and strike Ismael, and let no one know, lest he strike your soul and all Iouda gathered to you be scattered, and the remaining ones of Iouda will perish.

16 And Godolias said to Ioanan: Do not do this thing, because you speak false things concerning Ismael.

Chapter 48

1 And it happened in the seventh month, Ismael, son of Nathanias, son of Elasa, from the king's family, and ten men with him came to Godolias in Massepha, and they ate bread together there.

2 And Ismael and the ten men who were with him rose and struck Godolias, whom the king of Babylon appointed over the land,

3 and all the Ioudaians with him in Massepha and all the Chaldeans found there. —

4 And it happened on the second day after he struck Godolias, and no person knew,

5 men came from Sychem and from Salem and from Samareia, eighty men, with beards shaved and garments torn and lamenting, and manaa and frankincense in their hands to bring into the house of the Lord.

6 And Ismael went out to meet them; they were going and weeping, and he said to them, Enter to Godolias.

7 And it happened, when they entered into the middle of the city, he slaughtered them into the well.

8 And ten men were found there and said to Ismael: Do not kill us, because we have treasuries in a field, wheat and barley, honey and oil; and he passed by and did not kill them in the midst of their brothers.

9 And the well into which Ismael threw there all whom he struck, this is a great well which King Asa made because of Baasa, king of Israel; this Ismael filled with wounded ones.

10 And Ismael turned back all the people left in Massepha and the daughters of the king whom the chief cook entrusted to Godolias, son of Achikam, and went away to the region of the sons of Ammon. —

11 And Ioanan, son of Karee, and all the leaders of the force with him heard all the evils which Ismael did,

12 and they brought all their army and went to fight him and found him beside much water in Gabaon.

13 And it happened, when all the people with Ismael saw Ioanan and the leaders of the force with him,

14 they also returned to Ioanan.

15 And Ismael escaped with eight men and went away to the sons of Ammon. —

16 And Ioanan and all the leaders of the force with him took all the remaining ones of the people whom he brought back from Ismael, men mighty in war and the women and the other things and the eunuchs whom he brought back from Gabaon,

17 and they went and sat in Gaberoth — chamaam, toward Bethleem, to go to enter Egypt,

18 from before the Chaldeans, because they feared before them, because Ismael struck Godolias, whom the king of Babylon appointed in the land.

Chapter 49

1 And all the leaders of the force and Ioanan and Azarias, son of Maasaias, and all the people from small to great approached

2 Ieremias the prophet and said to him: Let our plea for mercy now fall before your face, and pray to the Lord your God concerning these remaining ones, because we were left few from many, as your eyes see;

3 and let the Lord your God announce to us the way on which we will go and a word which we will do.

4 And Ieremias said to them: I heard; behold, I will pray to the Lord our God according to your words; and it will be, the word which the Lord answers I will announce to you; I will certainly not hide a word from you.

5 And they said to Ieremias: Let the Lord be among us as a righteous and faithful witness, if we do not do thus according to every word with which the Lord sends you to us;

6 and whether good or evil, we will hear the voice of the Lord our God to whom we send you, so that it becomes better for us, because we will hear the voice of the Lord our God. —

7 And it happened after ten days, a word of the Lord came to Ieremias.

8 And he called Ioanan and the leaders of the force and all the people from small to great

9 and said to them: Thus said the Lord:

10 If you surely dwell in this land, I will build you and certainly not pull down, and plant you and certainly not pluck out; because I have rested from the evils which I did to you.

11 Do not fear before the king of Babylon before whom you fear; do not fear, says the Lord, because I am with you to deliver you and save you from his hand;

12 and I will give you mercy and have mercy on you and return you to your land.

13 And if you say, We will certainly not dwell in this land, so as not to hear the voice of the Lord,

14 because we will enter the land of Egypt and certainly not see war and certainly not hear a sound of a trumpet and certainly not hunger for bread, and there we will dwell,

15 therefore hear a word of the Lord: Thus said the Lord: If you set your face toward Egypt and enter there to dwell,

16 it will also be, the sword before which you fear will find you in the land of Egypt, and the famine about which you have concern will overtake you behind you in Egypt, and there you will die.

17 And all the people and all the foreigners who set their face toward the land of Egypt to dwell there will cease by sword and by famine, and there will be none of them saved from the evils which I am bringing upon them.

18 Because thus said the Lord: As my wrath dripped upon those dwelling in Ierusalem, thus my wrath will drip upon you when you enter Egypt, and you will be for an impassable place and subject to others and for a curse and for reproach, and you will certainly not see this place any longer,

19 things which the Lord spoke concerning you, the remaining ones of Iouda: Do not enter Egypt. And now you will surely know

20 that you acted wickedly in your souls, sending me, saying, Pray concerning us to the Lord, and according to everything which the Lord speaks to you we will do.

21 And you did not hear the voice of the Lord with which he sent me to you.

22 And now by sword and by famine you will cease in the place where you wish to enter to dwell there.

Chapter 50

1 And it happened, when Ieremias ceased saying to the people all the words of the Lord with which the Lord sent him to them, all these words,

2 Azarias, son of Maasaias, and Ioanan, son of Karee, and all the men said, those saying to Ieremias, saying, Falsehoods; the Lord did not send you to us, saying, Do not enter Egypt to dwell there,

3 but rather Barouch, son of Nerias, sets you against us, so that you give us into the hands of the Chaldeans to put us to death and deport us to Babylon.

4 And Ioanan and all the leaders of the force and all the people did not hear the voice of the Lord to dwell in the land of Iouda.

5 And Ioanan and all the leaders of the force took all the remaining ones of Iouda who returned to dwell in the land,

6 the mighty men and the women and the infants and the daughters of the king and the souls whom Nabouzardan left with Godolias, son of Achikam, and Ieremias the prophet and Barouch, son of Nerias,

7 and entered Egypt, because they did not hear the voice of the Lord; and they entered Taphnas.

8 And a word of the Lord came to Ieremias in Taphnas, saying,

9 Take for yourself great stones and hide them at the entrance, in the gate of Pharao's house in Taphnas, before the eyes of the men of Iouda,

10 and you will say: Thus said the Lord: Behold, I am sending and will bring Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, and he will set his throne above these stones which you hid and raise his weapons over them

11 and enter and strike the land of Egypt: those for death, to death, and those for deportation, to deportation, and those for sword, to sword.

12 And he will burn a fire in the houses of their gods and burn them and deport them and delouse the land of Egypt, just as a shepherd delouses his garment, and he will go out in peace.

13 And he will crush the pillars of the City of the Sun in On and burn up their houses with fire.

Chapter 51

1 The word that came to Ieremias for all the Ioudaians dwelling in the land of Egypt and those sitting in Magdolon and in Taphnas and in the land of Pathoures, saying,

2 Thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: You have seen all the evils which I brought upon Ierusalem and upon the cities of Iouda, and behold, they are desolate of inhabitants

3 because of their wickedness which they did to embitter me, going to burn incense to other gods which you did not know.

4 And I sent to you my servants the prophets at dawn and sent, saying, Do not do the thing of this defilement which I hated.

5 And they did not hear me and did not incline their ear to turn from their evils so as not to burn incense to other gods.

6 And my anger and my wrath dripped and blazed in the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem, and they became a desolation and an impassable place as this day.

7 And now thus said the Lord Almighty: Why do you do great evils against your souls, to cut off from you man and woman, infant and nursing one, from the midst of Iouda, so that none of you is left,

8 to embitter me with the works of your hands, burning incense to other gods in the land of Egypt into which you entered to dwell there, so that you are cut off and become a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the earth?

9 Have you forgotten the evils of your fathers and the evils of the kings of Iouda and the evils of your rulers and the evils of your wives which they did in the land of Iouda and outside Ierusalem?

10 And they did not cease until this day and did not hold fast to my ordinances which I gave before the face of their fathers.

11 Therefore thus said the Lord: Behold, I am setting my face

12 to destroy all the remaining ones in Egypt, and they will fall; by sword and by famine they will cease from small to great and will be for reproach and for destruction and for a curse.

13 And I will visit upon those sitting in the land of Egypt as I visited upon Ierusalem, by sword and by famine and by death,

14 and none of the remaining ones of Iouda sojourning in the land of Egypt will be saved to return to the land of Iouda, to which they hope in their souls to return there; they will certainly not return except those escaped. —

15 And all the men knowing that their wives burn incense to other gods and all the women, a great assembly, and all the people sitting in the land of Egypt in Pathoure answered Ieremias, saying,

16 The word which you spoke to us in the name of the Lord, we will not hear you,

17 because we will surely do every word which comes out of our mouth, to burn incense to the queen of heaven and pour libations to her, as we and our fathers and our kings and our rulers did in the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem, and we were filled with bread and became well and did not see evils;

18 and when we ceased burning incense to the queen of heaven, we were all diminished and ceased by sword and by famine.

19 And because we burn incense to the queen of heaven and poured libations to her, did we make chauonas for her and pour libations to her without our husbands? —

20 And Ieremias said to all the people, to the mighty ones and to the women and to all the people who answered him words, saying,

21 Did the Lord not remember the incense which you burned in the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem, you and your fathers and your kings and your rulers and the people of the land, and did it not come up upon his heart?

22 And the Lord could no longer bear because of the wickedness of your deeds, because of the abominations which you did; and your land became a desolation and an impassable place and a curse, as on this day,

23 because you were burning incense and sinned against the Lord and did not hear the voice of the Lord and did not walk in his ordinances and in his law and in his testimonies, and these evils overtook you.

24 And Ieremias said to the people and to the women: Hear the word of the Lord;

25 thus said the Lord, the God of Israel: You women spoke with your mouth and fulfilled with your hands, saying, We will surely do our vows which we vowed, to burn incense to the queen of heaven and pour libations to her; you surely remained in your vows and surely did them.

26 Therefore hear a word of the Lord, all Iouda sitting in the land of Egypt: Behold, I swore by my great name, said the Lord, that my name will no longer be in the mouth of all Iouda, to say, The Lord, the Lord lives, in all the land of Egypt.

27 Because behold, I have watched over them to harm them and not to do good, and all Iouda dwelling in the land of Egypt will cease by sword and by famine until they cease.

28 And those saved from sword will return to the land of Iouda few in number, and the remaining ones of Iouda who settled in the land of Egypt to dwell there will know whose word will remain.

29 And this is the sign for you, that I will visit upon you for evil things;

30 thus said the Lord: Behold, I am giving Ouaphre, king of Egypt, into the hands of his enemy and into the hands of those seeking his soul, as I gave Sedekias, king of Iouda, into the hands of Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, his enemy and the one seeking his soul.

31 The word which Ieremias the prophet spoke to Barouch, son of Nerias, when he was writing these words in the book from the mouth of Ieremias in the fourth year for Ioakim, son of Iosias, king of Iouda:

32 Thus said the Lord concerning you, Barouch:

33 Because you said, Alas, alas, because the Lord added toil to suffering for me; I slept in groanings, I did not find rest,

34 say to him: Thus said the Lord: Behold, those whom I built, I am pulling down, and those whom I planted, I am plucking out;

35 and do you seek great things for yourself? Do not seek, because behold, I am bringing evils upon all flesh, says the Lord, and I will give your soul as a find in every place wherever you go there.

Chapter 52

1 Sedekias being twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Ierusalem, and the name of his mother was Amitaal, daughter of Ieremias, from Lobena,

4 and it happened in the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, on the tenth of the month, Nabouchodonosor, king of Babylon, and all his force came against Ierusalem and made siegeworks around her and built around her with four-foot stones all around.

5 And the city came into confinement until the eleventh year for King Sedekias;

6 on the ninth of the month famine became firm in the city, and there were no loaves for the people of the land.

7 And the city was broken through, and all the men of war went out by night along the way of the gate between the wall and the outer wall, which was by the king's garden, and the Chaldeans were upon the city all around. And they went along the way to Araba,

8 and the force of the Chaldeans pursued after the king and overtook him in the region of Iericho, and all his servants were scattered from him.

9 And they seized the king and brought him to the king of Babylon in Deblatha, and he spoke to him with judgment;

10 and the king of Babylon slaughtered the sons of Sedekias before his eyes, and all the rulers of Iouda he slaughtered in Deblatha;

11 and he blinded the eyes of Sedekias and bound him in fetters, and the king of Babylon brought him to Babylon and put him into a mill house until the day on which he died.

12 And in the fifth month, on the tenth of the month, Nabouzardan the chief cook, standing before the face of the king of Babylon, came to Ierusalem.

13 And he burned the house of the Lord and the house of the king and all the houses of the city, and every great house he burned with fire.

14 And all the wall of Ierusalem all around the force of the Chaldeans with the chief cook pulled down.

16 And the remaining ones of the people the chief cook left as vine workers and farmers.

17 And the bronze pillars in the house of the Lord and the bases and the bronze sea in the house of the Lord the Chaldeans crushed and took their bronze and carried it away to Babylon.

18 And the crown and the bowls and the meat hooks and all the bronze vessels with which they ministered,

19 and the sapphoth and the masmaroth and the pouring vessels and the lampstands and the incense dishes and the ladles, those which were gold, gold, and those which were silver, silver, the chief cook took.

20 And the two pillars and the one sea and the twelve bronze calves beneath the sea, which King Salomon made for the house of the Lord; there was no weight for their bronze.

21 And the pillars, thirty-five cubits the height of the one pillar, and a cord of twelve cubits encircled it, and its thickness four fingers all around,

22 and a bronze cornice upon them, and five cubits the length, the projection of the one cornice, and a net and pomegranates upon the cornice all around, all bronze; and according to these for the second pillar, eight pomegranates to the cubit for the twelve cubits.

23 And the pomegranates were ninety-six on the one part, and all the pomegranates upon the net all around were a hundred.

24 And the chief cook took the first priest and the second priest and the three guarding the way

25 and one eunuch who was overseer of the men of war, and seven renowned men before the face of the king found in the city and the scribe of the forces serving as scribe for the people of the land, and sixty people from the people of the land found in the midst of the city;

26 and Nabouzardan the chief cook took them and brought them to the king of Babylon in Deblatha,

27 and the king of Babylon struck them in Deblatha in the land of Aimath.

31 And it happened in the thirty-seventh year after Ioakim, king of Iouda, was deported, in the twelfth month, on the twenty-fourth of the month, Oulaimaradach, king of Babylon, in the year in which he reigned, lifted the head of Ioakim, king of Iouda, and brought him out of the house in which he was guarded;

32 and he spoke good things to him and placed his throne above the thrones of the kings with him in Babylon;

33 and he changed his prison robe, and he ate bread continually before his face all the days which he lived;

34 and his allowance was given continually by the king of Babylon, day by day, until the day on which he died.

Baruch

Chapter 1

1 And these are the words of the book which Barouch son of Nerias son of Maasaias son of Sedekias son of Asadias son of Chelkias wrote in Babylon

2 in the fifth year, on the seventh of the month, at the time when the Chaldeans took Ierusalem and burned it with fire.

3 And Barouch read the words of this book in the ears of Iechonias son of Ioakim king of Iouda and in the ears of all the people who came to the book,

4 and in the ears of the mighty and sons of the kings and in the ears of the elders and in the ears of all the people, from small to great, all who dwelt in Babylon by the river Soud.

5 And they wept and fasted and prayed before the Lord,

6 and gathered silver according as each one's hand was able,

7 and sent to Ierusalem to Ioakim son of Chelkias son of Salom, the priest, and to the priests and to all the people who were found with him in Ierusalem,

8 when he took the vessels of the Lord's house which had been brought out of the temple, to return them to the land of Iouda on the tenth of Siouan, silver vessels which Sedekias son of Iosias king of Iouda made,

9 after Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon deported Iechonias and the rulers and the prisoners and the mighty and the people of the land from Ierusalem and brought him to Babylon.

10 And they said, Behold, we have sent silver to you; and buy with the silver whole burnt offerings and offerings concerning sin and frankincense, and make manna and offer upon the altar of the Lord our God,

11 and pray concerning the life of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon and for the life of Baltasar his son, that their days may be as the days of heaven upon the earth.

12 And the Lord will give us strength and illuminate our eyes, and we shall live under the shadow of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon and under the shadow of Baltasar his son, and serve them many days and find favor before them.

13 And pray concerning us to the Lord our God, because we sinned against the Lord our God, and the Lord's wrath and his anger have not turned away from us until this day.

14 And you shall read this book which we sent to you, to declare in the Lord's house on a feast day and on days of an appointed time,

15 and you shall say, To the Lord our God belongs righteousness, but to us shame of faces, as this day, to the person of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem,

16 and to our kings and to our rulers and to our priests and to our prophets and to our fathers,

17 inasmuch as we sinned before the Lord

18 and disobeyed him and did not hear the voice of the Lord our God, to walk in the Lord's ordinances which he gave before our face.

19 From the day when the Lord brought our fathers out of the land of Egypt until this day, we were disobedient toward the Lord our God and acted heedlessly so as not to hear his voice.

20 And the evils clung to us, and the curse which the Lord prescribed to Moyses his servant on the day when he brought our fathers out of the land of Egypt to give us a land flowing with milk and honey, as this day.

21 And we did not hear the voice of the Lord our God according to all the words of the prophets whom he sent to us,

22 and we went, each in the thought of his evil heart, to serve other gods, to do evil things before the eyes of the Lord our God.

Chapter 2

1 And the Lord established his word which he spoke against us and against our judges who judged Israel and against our kings and against our rulers and against the person of Israel and Iouda.

2 It was not done beneath all heaven as he did in Ierusalem, according to the things written in the law of Moyses,

3 that we should eat, a person the flesh of his son and a person the flesh of his daughter.

4 And he gave them into the hands of all the kingdoms around us, for reproach and for an untrodden place among all the peoples round about, where the Lord scattered them there.

5 And they became beneath and not above, because we sinned against the Lord our God by not hearing his voice. —

6 To the Lord our God belongs righteousness, but to us and to our fathers shame of faces, as this day.

7 What the Lord spoke against us, all these evils came upon us.

8 And we did not entreat the face of the Lord, that each should turn from the thoughts of their evil heart.

9 And the Lord watched over the evils, and the Lord brought them upon us, because the Lord is righteous in all his works which he commanded us.

10 And we did not hear his voice, to walk in the Lord's ordinances which he gave before our face. —

11 And now, Lord, God of Israel, who brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand and with signs and with wonders and with great power and with a high arm, and made yourself a name, as this day,

12 we sinned, we acted impiously, we acted unjustly, Lord our God, against all your just requirements.

13 Let your wrath turn away from us, because we were left few among the nations where you scattered us there.

14 Hear, Lord, our prayer and our supplication, and deliver us for your sake and give us favor before the face of those who deported us,

15 that all the earth may know that you are the Lord our God, because your name was called upon Israel and upon his race.

16 Lord, look down from your holy house and consider us; incline, Lord, your ear and hear;

17 open, Lord, your eyes and see; because the dead in Hades, whose spirit was taken from their inward parts, will not give glory and a just acknowledgment to the Lord,

18 but the soul grieving greatly, that which walks stooping and weak, and the failing eyes and the hungry soul will give you glory and righteousness, Lord.

19 Because it is not upon the just deeds of our fathers and our kings that we lay down our plea for mercy before your face, Lord our God,

20 because you let your wrath and your anger into us, just as you spoke by the hand of your servants the prophets, saying,

21 Thus said the Lord, Incline your shoulder and serve the king of Babylon and dwell upon the land which I gave to your fathers;

22 and if you do not hear the voice of the Lord, to serve the king of Babylon,

23 I will cause to cease from the cities of Iouda and outside Ierusalem the voice of gladness and the voice of joy, the voice of bridegroom and the voice of bride, and all the land will be untrodden, without inhabitants.

24 And we did not hear your voice, to serve the king of Babylon, and you established your words which you spoke by the hands of your servants the prophets, that the bones of our kings and the bones of our fathers should be brought out of their place,

25 and behold, they are cast out to the heat of the day and to the frost of the night, and they died in evil afflictions, in famine and by the sword and by a sending away.

26 And you made the house upon which your name was called as this day, because of the wickedness of the house of Israel and the house of Iouda. —

27 And you dealt with us, Lord our God, according to all your forbearance and according to all your great compassion,

28 as you spoke by the hand of your servant Moyses on the day when you commanded him to write your law before the sons of Israel, saying,

29 If you do not hear my voice, surely this great, abundant clamor will turn to a small one among the nations where I shall scatter them there;

30 because I knew that they would certainly not hear me, because they are a stiff-necked people. And they will return to their heart in the land of their deportation

31 and know that I am the Lord their God. And I will give them a heart and ears that hear,

32 and they will praise me in the land of their deportation and remember my name

33 and turn away from their stiff back and from their evil deeds, because they will remember the way of their fathers who sinned before the Lord.

34 And I will return them to the land which I swore to their fathers, to Abraam and to Isaak and to Iakob, and they shall rule over it; and I will multiply them, and they shall certainly not be diminished;

35 and I will establish an everlasting covenant for them, that I should be God to them and they shall be a people to me; and I will no longer move my people Israel from the land which I gave them. —

Chapter 3

1 Lord Almighty, God of Israel, a soul in straits and a spirit of despondency has cried to you.

2 Hear, Lord, and have mercy, because we sinned before you;

3 because you sit forever, and we perish forever.

4 Lord Almighty, God of Israel, hear indeed the prayer of the dead of Israel and of the sons of those who sin before you, who did not hear the voice of the Lord their God, and the evils clung to us.

5 Do not remember our fathers' injustices, but remember your hand and your name at this time;

6 because you are the Lord our God, and we shall praise you, Lord.

7 Because for this reason you gave your fear upon our heart, to call upon your name, and we shall praise you in our exile, because we turned away from our heart all the injustice of our fathers who sinned before you.

8 Behold, we today are in our exile, where you scattered us there, for reproach and for a curse and for a liability, according to all the injustices of our fathers who departed from the Lord our God.

9 Hear, Israel, commandments of life; give ear to know understanding.

10 What is it, Israel? Why is it that you are in the land of enemies, you grew old in a foreign land,

11 you were defiled with the dead, you were counted with those in Hades?

12 You abandoned the fountain of wisdom.

13 If you had walked in the way of God, you would have dwelt in peace forever.

14 Learn where understanding is, where strength is, where comprehension is, to know at once where length of days and life are, where light of eyes and peace are. —

15 Who found her place, and who entered her treasuries?

16 Where are the rulers of the nations and those who rule over the beasts upon the earth,

17 those who sport with the birds of heaven and treasure up silver and gold in which people had trusted, and there is no end of their acquisition,

18 those who fashion silver and take pains, and there is no finding out of their works?

19 They vanished and went down to Hades, and others rose in their place.

20 Younger ones saw light and dwelt upon the earth, but they did not know the way of knowledge,

21 nor comprehend her paths nor lay hold of her; their sons became far from their way.

22 Nor was she heard in Chanaan nor seen in Thaiman,

23 nor did the sons of Agar who seek out comprehension upon the earth, the merchants of Merran and Thaiman, the tellers of tales and the seekers of comprehension, know the way of wisdom, nor did they remember her paths. —

24 O Israel, how great is the house of God and how extensive the place of his possession!

25 Great and it has no end, high and immeasurable.

26 There were born the renowned giants of the beginning, who became of great size, skilled in war.

27 God did not choose these, nor give them the way of knowledge;

28 and they perished through not having understanding, they perished because of their lack of counsel. —

29 Who ascended into heaven and took her and brought her down from the clouds?

30 Who crossed beyond the sea and found her and will bring her for choice gold?

31 There is none who knows her way nor who considers her path;

32 but he who knows all things knows her; he found her by his comprehension; he who prepared the earth for everlasting time filled it with four-footed animals;

33 he who sends out the light, and it goes, called it, and it obeyed him with trembling;

34 and the stars shone in their watches and were glad;

35 he called them and they said, We are here; they shone with gladness for him who made them.

36 This is our God; no other shall be reckoned beside him.

37 He found every way of knowledge and gave it to Iakob his servant and Israel who was loved by him;

38 after this he appeared upon the earth and lived among people.

Chapter 4

1 This is the book of the ordinances of God and the law which exists forever; all who hold fast to her are for life, but those who abandon her will die. —

2 Return, Iakob, and take hold of her; go through toward the radiance, facing her light.

3 Do not give your glory to another and the things beneficial to you to a foreign nation.

4 Blessed are we, Israel, because the things pleasing to God are known to us.

5 Take courage, my people, memorial of Israel.

6 You were sold to the nations, not for destruction, but because you provoked God to anger you were handed over to adversaries;

7 for you provoked him who made you, sacrificing to demons and not to God.

8 And you forgot the everlasting God who nourished you, and you also grieved Ierusalem who reared you;

9 for she saw the anger which came upon you from God and said, Hear, neighboring women of Sion, God brought great mourning upon me;

10 for I saw the captivity of my sons and daughters which the Everlasting brought upon them;

11 for I nourished them with gladness, but sent them away with weeping and mourning.

12 Let no one rejoice over me, the widow abandoned by many; I was made desolate because of the sins of my children, because they turned aside from God's law,

13 and did not know his just requirements nor walk in the ways of God's commandments nor tread paths of discipline in his righteousness.

14 Let the neighboring women of Sion come, and remember the captivity of my sons and daughters which the Everlasting brought upon them;

15 for he brought upon them a nation from afar, a shameless nation of another tongue, who did not respect an elder nor have mercy on a child,

16 and led away the widow's beloved ones and left the solitary woman bereft of her daughters.

17 But how am I able to help you?

18 For he who brought the evils upon you will deliver you from the hand of your enemies.

19 Go, children, go; for I was left desolate;

20 I took off the robe of peace, and put on the sackcloth of my supplication; I shall cry to the Everlasting in my days. —

21 Take courage, children; cry to God, and he will deliver you from domination, from the hand of enemies.

22 For I hoped in the Everlasting for your salvation, and joy came to me from the Holy One at the mercy which will come to you quickly from your everlasting Savior.

23 For I sent you out with mourning and weeping, but God will give you back to me with joy and gladness forever.

24 For just as the neighboring women of Sion have now seen your captivity, so they will quickly see the salvation from your God which will come upon you with great glory and splendor of the Everlasting.

25 Children, endure patiently the anger from God which came upon you; your enemy pursued you, and you will see his destruction quickly and tread upon their necks.

26 My delicate ones went rough ways; they were taken away as a flock seized by enemies. —

27 Take courage, children, and cry to God; for there will be remembrance of you by him who brought it upon you.

28 For just as your thought was to stray from God, multiply tenfold, having returned, your seeking of him.

29 For he who brought the evils upon you will bring everlasting gladness upon you with your salvation.

30 Take courage, Ierusalem; he who named you will comfort you.

31 Wretched are those who afflicted you and rejoiced over your fall,

32 wretched the cities which your children served, wretched she who received your sons.

33 For just as she rejoiced at your fall and was glad at your downfall, so she will grieve at her own desolation.

34 And I will remove from her the exultation of her great throng, and her pride will become mourning.

35 For fire will come upon her from the Everlasting for long days, and she will be inhabited by demons for a longer time. —

36 Look around toward the east, Ierusalem, and see the gladness coming to you from God.

37 Behold, your sons whom you sent away are coming; they come gathered from east to west at the word of the Holy One, rejoicing in the glory of God. —

Chapter 5

1 Take off, Ierusalem, the robe of mourning and of your affliction, and put on the comeliness of the glory from God forever.

2 Wrap yourself in the double cloak of the righteousness from God; set upon your head the headdress of the glory of the Everlasting.

3 For God will show your splendor to all that is under heaven.

4 For your name will be called by God forever, Peace of righteousness and glory of reverence for God. —

5 Rise, Ierusalem, and stand upon the height and look around toward the east and see your children gathered from the setting of the sun to its rising at the word of the Holy One, rejoicing in the remembrance of God.

6 For they went out from you on foot, led by enemies, but God brings them in to you, borne with glory as a throne of kingship.

7 For God commanded every high mountain and everlasting dunes to be lowered and ravines to be filled for the leveling of the earth, that Israel might walk safely in the glory of God;

8 and the woods and every fragrant tree shaded Israel at the command of God;

9 for God will lead Israel with gladness by the light of his glory, with mercy and righteousness from him.

Lamentations

Chapter 1

1 t And it happened after Israel was taken captive and Ierusalem made desolate, Ieremias sat weeping and lamented this lament over Ierusalem and said,

1 How did the city filled with peoples sit alone? She became like a widow, filled among nations; ruling among countries, she became subject to tribute.

2 Weeping, she wept in the night, and her tears were upon her cheeks, and there is none comforting her among all who love her; all her friends dealt faithlessly with her, became enemies to her.

3 Ioudaia was removed from her humiliation and from the abundance of her servitude; she sat among nations, found no rest; all who pursued her overtook her amid those who afflict her.

4 The ways of Sion mourn because there are none coming at a feast; all her gates are destroyed, her priests groan, her virgins are led away, and she is embittered within herself.

5 Those who afflict her became the head, and her enemies prospered, because the Lord humbled her for the multitude of her impieties; her infants went into captivity before the face of an afflicter.

6 And all her comeliness went out from daughter Sion; her rulers became like rams finding no pasture, and went without strength before the face of a pursuer.

7 Ierusalem remembered the days of her humiliation and her rejection, all her desirable things which were from ancient days, when her people fell into the hands of an afflicter and there was none helping her; her enemies saw and laughed at her removal.

8 Ierusalem sinned a sin; therefore she became a shaking; all who honored her humbled her, for they saw her indecency, and indeed she herself groaned and turned backward.

9 Her uncleanness is at her feet; she did not remember her last things; and she brought down things exceedingly great; there is none comforting her. See, Lord, my humiliation, because an enemy was magnified.

10 An afflicter spread his hand over all her desirable things; for she saw nations enter her sanctuary, whom you commanded not to enter your assembly.

11 All her people groan, seeking bread; they gave her desirable things for food, to restore a soul. See, Lord, and look, because I became dishonored.

12 Not to you, all who pass along the way; turn and see whether there is pain like my pain which came about; speaking against me, the Lord humbled me on the day of the anger of his wrath.

13 From his height he sent fire, into my bones he brought it down; he spread a net for my feet, turned me backward, made me destroyed, suffering all the day.

14 Watch was kept over my impieties; in my hands they were intertwined, they rose upon my neck; my strength grew weak, because the Lord gave pains into my hands; I shall not be able to stand.

15 The Lord removed all my strong ones from my midst, called an appointed time against me to crush my chosen ones; the Lord trod a winepress for the virgin daughter of Iouda; for these things I weep.

16 My eye brought down water, because he who comforts me, who restores my soul, was far from me; my sons became destroyed, because the enemy grew strong.

17 Sion spread her hands; there is none comforting her; the Lord commanded concerning Iakob, those who afflict him round about him; Ierusalem became as a woman sitting apart among them.

18 The Lord is righteous, because I provoked his mouth to bitterness. Hear indeed, all peoples, and see my pain; my virgins and my young men went into captivity.

19 I called my lovers, but they deceived me; my priests and my elders failed in the city, because they sought food for themselves to restore their souls, and found none.

20 See, Lord, because I am afflicted; my belly was troubled, and my heart turned within me, because provoking to bitterness, I provoked to bitterness; outside a sword bereaved me, as death in the house.

21 Hear indeed that I groan; there is none comforting me; all my enemies heard my evils and rejoiced, because you did it; you brought a day, called an appointed time, and they became like me.

22 May all their wickedness come before your face, and glean them as they made a gleaning concerning all my sins, because my groans are many, and my heart grieves.

Chapter 2

1 How did the Lord darken daughter Sion in his anger? He cast down Israel's glory from heaven to earth and did not remember the footstool of his feet on the day of his anger.

2 The Lord engulfed without sparing all the beautiful things of Iakob, pulled down in his wrath the strongholds of daughter Iouda, fastened them to the earth, profaned her king and her rulers.

3 He broke every horn of Israel in the anger of his wrath, turned his right hand backward from the face of an enemy and kindled in Iakob as fire a flame, and it devoured all things round about.

4 He stretched his bow like an enemy, made his right hand firm like an adversary and killed all the desirable things of my eyes in the tent of daughter Sion; he poured out his wrath like fire.

5 The Lord became like an enemy, engulfed Israel, engulfed all her citadels, destroyed his strongholds and multiplied for daughter Iouda humiliation upon humiliation.

6 And he spread his dwelling like a vine, destroyed his feast; the Lord forgot what he made in Sion, feast and sabbath, and provoked king and priest and ruler with the vehemence of his anger.

7 The Lord rejected his altar, shook off his sanctuary, crushed the wall of her citadels in the hand of an enemy; they gave a voice in the Lord's house as on a feast day.

8 And the Lord turned to destroy the wall of daughter Sion; he stretched a measure, did not turn his hand away from trampling, and the outer wall mourned, and the wall together grew weak.

9 Her gates were fixed into the earth; he destroyed and crushed her bars; her king and her rulers among the nations; there is no law, and indeed her prophets saw no vision from the Lord.

10 The elders of daughter Sion sat upon the earth, kept silent, put dust upon their head, girded themselves with sackcloth; they brought down to earth the leading virgins in Ierusalem.

11 My eyes failed in tears, my heart was troubled, my glory was poured out upon the earth over the crushing of the daughter of my people, when infant and suckling failed in the city's squares.

12 They said to their mothers, Where are grain and wine? When they fainted like wounded ones in the city's squares, when their souls were poured out into their mothers' bosom.

13 What shall I testify to you, or what shall I liken to you, daughter Ierusalem? Who will save you and comfort you, virgin daughter Sion? Because the cup of your crushing was made great; who will heal you?

14 Your prophets saw vain things and folly for you and did not uncover your injustice to turn back your captivity, and saw vain pronouncements and expulsions for you.

15 All who pass along the way clapped hands over you, hissed and shook their head over daughter Ierusalem: Is this the city which they will call Crown of glory, gladness of all the earth?

16 All your enemies opened their mouth wide against you, hissed and gnashed teeth, said, We swallowed her; surely this is the day which we expected; we found it, we saw.

17 The Lord did what he considered, fulfilled his words which he commanded from ancient days, pulled down and did not spare, and made an enemy glad over you, raised the horn of him who afflicts you.

18 Their heart cried to the Lord, Walls of Sion, bring down tears like torrents by day and night; give yourself no respite; let your eye not be silent, daughter.

19 Rise, exult in the night at the beginnings of your watch; pour out your heart like water before the face of the Lord; lift your hands toward him concerning the soul of your infants who faint with famine at the beginning of all the exits.

20 See, Lord, and look upon whom you gleaned thus; shall women eat the fruit of their womb? A cook made a gleaning; shall infants sucking breasts be murdered? Will you kill priest and prophet in the Lord's sanctuary?

21 Child and elder lay down at the exit; my virgins and my young men went into captivity; by sword and by famine you killed, on the day of your anger you slaughtered, you did not spare.

22 He called a feast day of my sojourning from round about, and on the day of the Lord's anger there were none escaping and remaining, as I prevailed and multiplied all my enemies.

Chapter 3

1 I am the man who sees poverty under the rod of his wrath upon me;

2 he took me and led me away into darkness and not light,

3 surely against me he turned his hand all the day.

4 He made my flesh and my skin old, crushed my bones;

5 he built against me and encircled my head and labored,

6 in dark places he seated me like the dead of old.

7 He built against me, and I shall not go out; he made my bronze heavy;

8 and indeed I shall cry and shout; he blocked my prayer;

9 he built up my ways, blocked my paths, troubled them.

10 He is a bear lying in wait for me, a lion in hidden places;

11 he pursued me when I stood apart and brought me to a halt, made me destroyed;

12 he stretched his bow and set me up as a target for an arrow.

13 He brought the arrows of his quiver into my kidneys;

14 I became a laughingstock to all my people, their song all the day;

15 he filled me with bitterness, made me drunk with gall.

16 And he knocked out my teeth with a pebble, fed me ash;

17 and he thrust my soul away from peace; I forgot good things

18 and said, My strife perished, and my hope from the Lord.

19 I remembered from my poverty and from my persecution my bitterness and gall;

20 my soul will remember and ponder over me;

21 this I shall set in my heart; therefore I shall wait.

25 The Lord is good to those who wait for him, to the soul which will seek him, good,

26 and will wait and be quiet for the salvation of the Lord.

27 It is good for a man when he takes up a yoke in his youth.

28 He will sit alone and keep silent, because he took it upon himself;

30 he will give a cheek to him who strikes him, will be filled with reproaches.

31 Because the Lord will not reject forever;

32 because he who humbled will have compassion according to the abundance of his mercy;

33 because he did not answer from his heart and humbled sons of man.

34 To humble beneath his feet all prisoners of earth,

35 to turn aside the judgment of a man before the face of the Most High,
36 to condemn a person when he is judged, the Lord did not say.
37 Who spoke thus, and it happened? The Lord did not command,
38 will not the evils and the good come out of the mouth of the Most High?
39 Why will a living person grumble, a man concerning his sin?
40 Our way was searched out and examined, and let us return to the Lord;
41 let us lift our hearts upon hands toward the High One in heaven.
42 We sinned, acted impiously, and you were not propitiated.
43 You covered in wrath and pursued us; you killed, did not spare.
44 You covered yourself with a cloud on account of prayer,
45 to shut my eyes and to be thrust away, you placed us amid the peoples.
46 All our enemies opened their mouth wide against us;
47 fear and wrath came to us, lifting up and crushing;
48 my eye will bring down outflows of water over the crushing of the daughter of my people.
49 My eye was swallowed up, and I shall not keep silent, because there is no respite,
50 until the Lord bends down and sees from heaven;
51 my eye will glean upon my soul beyond all the daughters of a city.
52 Hunting, my enemies hunted me like a sparrow without cause,
53 they put my life to death in a pit and laid a stone upon me,
54 water poured over my head; I said, I am rejected.
55 I called upon your name, Lord, from the lowest pit;
56 you heard my voice: Do not hide your ears from my supplication.
57 You drew near to my help on the day when I called upon you; you said to me, Do not fear.
58 You judged, Lord, the cases of my soul, redeemed my life;
59 you saw, Lord, my troubles, judged my judgment;
60 you saw all their vengeance, in all their designs against me.
61 You heard their reproach, all their designs against me,
62 the lips of those rising against me and their meditations against me all the day,
63 their sitting and their rising; look upon their eyes.
64 You will give them recompense, Lord, according to the works of their hands,
65 you will give them a shield of heart, your toil to them,
66 you will pursue in anger and consume them beneath heaven, Lord.

Chapter 4

1 How will gold be dimmed, the good silver altered? Holy stones were poured out at the beginning of all the exits.

2 The precious sons of Sion, exalted in gold, how were they reckoned as earthen vessels, works of a potter's hands?

3 And indeed dragons uncovered breasts, their cubs suckled; daughters of my people became incurable, like a sparrow in a wilderness.

4 The suckling's tongue clung to his throat in thirst; infants asked for bread, there is none breaking it for them.

5 Those eating delicacies vanished in the exits; those nursed upon scarlet wrapped themselves in dung heaps.

6 And the lawlessness of the daughter of my people was made greater than the lawlessness of Sodoma, overthrown as in haste, and they did not labor with hands in her.

7 Her Nazirites were made purer than snow, shone beyond milk; they were made red beyond sapphire stones in their cut form.

8 Their appearance darkened beyond soot, they were not recognized in the exits; their skin was fixed upon their bones, they dried up, became like wood.

9 Those wounded by sword were better than those wounded by famine; they went pierced through, deprived of the produce of fields.

10 Hands of compassionate women boiled their children; they became food for them in the crushing of the daughter of my people.

11 The Lord completed his wrath, poured out the wrath of his anger and kindled fire in Sion, and it devoured her foundations.

12 Kings of earth did not believe, all who inhabit the inhabited world, that an enemy and an afflicter would enter through the gates of Ierusalem.

13 From the sins of her prophets, the injustices of her priests who pour out righteous blood in her midst.

14 Her watchers were shaken in the exits, defiled with blood; when they could not, they touched their garments.

15 Depart from unclean ones — call them — depart, depart, do not touch, because they were kindled and indeed shaken; say among the nations, They shall certainly not continue to sojourn.

16 The face of the Lord is their portion; he will not continue to look upon them; they did not regard the face of priests, did not have mercy on elders.

17 While we still existed, our eyes failed toward our help in vain; watching from afar, we watched for a nation that does not save.

18 We hunted our little ones, so that they should not walk in our squares; our time has drawn near, our days were fulfilled, our time is present.

19 Those pursuing us became swifter than eagles of heaven; upon the mountains they were kindled, in a wilderness they lay in wait for us.

20 The breath of our face, the Lord's anointed, was captured in their destructions, of whom we said, In his shadow we shall live among the nations.

21 Rejoice and be glad, daughter of Idoumaia who dwells upon earth; indeed the cup of the Lord will pass to you, and you will be made drunk and pour out.

22 Your lawlessness ceased, daughter Sion; he will no longer deport you. He visited your lawlessnesses, daughter Edom; he uncovered your impieties.

Chapter 5

1 Remember, Lord, what happened to us; look and see our reproach.

2 Our inheritance was turned over to foreigners, our houses to strangers.

3 We became orphans, there is no father; our mothers are like widows.

4 From our days our wood came in exchange.

5 Upon our neck we were pursued; we labored, did not rest.

6 Egypt gave a hand, Assour for their fullness.

7 Our fathers sinned, they do not exist; we bore their lawless deeds.

8 Slaves ruled over us; there is none redeeming from their hand.

9 At the cost of our souls we shall bring in our bread from the face of the sword of the wilderness.

10 Our skin became livid like an oven; they shriveled from the face of storms of famine.

11 They humbled women in Sion, virgins in the cities of Iouda.

12 Rulers were hung by their hands, elders were not honored.

13 Chosen ones took up weeping, and young men grew weak with wood.

14 And elders ceased from the gate, chosen ones ceased from their songs.

15 The joy of our heart ceased, our dance turned to mourning.

16 The crown of our head fell; woe indeed to us, because we sinned.

17 Concerning this our heart became painful, concerning this our eyes darkened;

18 over mount Sion, because it was destroyed; foxes passed through her.

19 But you, Lord, will dwell forever, your throne to generation and generation.

20 Why will you forget us for strife, abandon us for length of days?

21 Return us, Lord, to you, and we shall return; and renew our days as before.

22 Because rejecting, you rejected us, you were exceedingly angry against us.

Letter of Jeremiah

Chapter 1

1 Copy of a letter which Ieremias sent to those who would be led captive to Babylon by the king of the Babylonians, to announce to them according as he was commanded by God.

1 Because of the sins which you sinned before God, you will be led captive to Babylon by Nabouchodonosor king of the Babylonians.

2 Therefore, having entered Babylon, you will be there many years and a long time, until seven generations; but after this I will bring you out from there with peace.

3 And now you will see in Babylon silver and golden and wooden gods borne upon shoulders, displaying fear to the nations.

4 Therefore beware lest you too, being made like the foreigners, should be made like them, and fear should seize you concerning them,

5 when you see a crowd before and behind them worshiping them; but say in your thought, You must be worshiped, Master.

6 For my angel is with you, and he seeks out your souls.

7 For their tongue is scraped by a craftsman, and they are overlaid with gold and silver, but are false and cannot speak.

8 And taking gold, as for a maiden fond of adornment, they fashion crowns upon the heads of their gods;

9 and sometimes the priests secretly take gold and silver from their gods and spend it on themselves, and they will give some of it also to the prostitutes upon the roof.

10 And they adorn them with garments like people, silver and golden and wooden gods; but these are not preserved from corrosion and things that eat them.

11 Though they are clothed in purple apparel, they wipe their face because of the dust from the house, which is abundant upon them.

12 And it has a scepter like a person judging a country, who will not kill him who sins against it.

13 And it has a dagger in its right hand and an axe, but it will not deliver itself from war and robbers.

14 From this they are known to be no gods; therefore do not fear them.

15 For just as a person's vessel, when broken, becomes useless, such are their gods, when they are installed in the houses.

16 Their eyes are full of dust from the feet of those entering.

17 And just as the courts are fenced around for someone who has wronged a king, as for one led away to death, the priests fortify their houses with doors and locks and bars, so that they may not be plundered by robbers.

18 They burn lamps, even more than for themselves, not one of which they can see.

19 It is indeed like a beam from the house, and they say that their hearts are licked away; when creeping things from the earth devour them and their apparel, they do not perceive it.

20 Their face is blackened from the smoke from the house.

21 Upon their body and upon their head bats, swallows and birds alight, and likewise also cats.

22 From this you will know that they are not gods; therefore do not fear them.

23 For the gold which they wear for beauty, unless someone wipes off the corrosion, they shall certainly not shine; for neither, when they were being cast, did they perceive it.

24 They are bought at every price, and there is no spirit in them.

25 Without feet they are carried upon shoulders, displaying their own dishonor to people, and those who attend them are also ashamed because, if it should fall to the earth, it must rise through them;

26 neither if someone stands it upright will it move of itself, nor if it is tilted will it certainly be set upright, but gifts are set before them as before dead ones.

27 And their priests sell their sacrifices and use them for themselves; likewise also their wives preserve some of them and share neither with a poor person nor with a powerless one; a woman sitting apart and a woman in childbirth touch their sacrifices.

28 Therefore, knowing from these things that they are not gods, do not fear them.

29 For how could they be called gods? Because women set offerings before silver and golden and wooden gods;

30 and in their houses the priests sit upon seats with their tunics torn and their heads and beards shaved, whose heads are uncovered,

31 and they howl, shouting before their gods like some at a funeral banquet for a dead person.

32 The priests take from their apparel and clothe their wives and children.

33 Neither if they suffer evil from someone nor if good will they be able to repay; neither can they appoint a king nor remove one.

34 Likewise they shall certainly not be able to give wealth or bronze; if someone, having vowed a vow to them, does not pay it, they shall certainly not demand it.

35 They shall certainly not rescue a person from death nor deliver a weaker one from a strong one.

36 They shall certainly not bring a blind person to sight, nor deliver a person who is in distress.

37 They shall certainly not have mercy on a widow nor do good to an orphan.

38 The wooden and gold-overlaid and silver-overlaid ones are likened to stones from the mountain, and those who attend them will be put to shame.

39 How then must they be considered or called to be gods?

40 And further, even the Chaldeans themselves dishonor them, who, whenever they see a mute unable to speak, bring him to Bel and ask him to utter a sound, as though he were able to perceive,

41 and they themselves cannot, having understood, abandon them, for they have no perception.

42 And the women, having put cords around themselves, sit in the roads burning bran as incense;

43 and whenever one of them, drawn away by one of those passing by, lies with him, she reproaches her neighbor because she was not deemed worthy as she herself was, nor was her cord torn.

44 All the things done for them are false; how then must it be considered or said that they are gods?

45 They are fashioned by craftsmen and goldsmiths; they shall become nothing else than what the artisans wish them to become.

46 And those who fashion them themselves shall certainly not become long-lived; how indeed are the things fashioned by them going to be gods?

47 For they left falsehoods and reproach to those coming after.

48 For whenever war and evils come upon them, the priests deliberate among themselves where they may hide together with them.

49 How then is it not possible to perceive that they are not gods, who save themselves neither from war nor from evils?

50 For being wooden and overlaid with gold and silver, it will be known after these things that they are false; to all the nations and to the kings it will be manifest that they are not gods but works of human hands, and there is no work of God in them.

51 By what then must it be known that they are not gods?

52 For they shall certainly not raise up a king of a country nor give rain to people,

53 and they shall certainly not decide their judgment nor rescue one who is wronged, being powerless; for they are like crows between heaven and earth.

54 For also whenever fire falls into a house of wooden or gold-overlaid or silver-overlaid gods, their priests will flee and be saved, but they themselves will be burned up like beams in the midst.

55 And they shall certainly not withstand a king and enemies.

56 How then must it be accepted or considered that they are gods?

57 Neither from thieves nor from robbers shall wooden and silver-overlaid and gold-overlaid gods be saved, whose gold and silver and apparel which surrounds them the strong will strip off and go away possessing, nor shall they certainly help themselves;

58 so that a king displaying his own courage, or a useful vessel in a house which its possessor will use, is better than the false gods; or also a door in a house preserving the things in it is better than the false gods, and a wooden pillar in royal dwellings than the false gods.

59 For sun and moon and stars, being bright and sent forth for needs, are obedient;

60 likewise also lightning, whenever it appears, is plainly seen; and the same wind blows in every country;

61 and whenever the clouds are commanded by God to go over all the inhabited world, they fulfill what was ordered; and the fire sent forth from above to consume mountains and woods does what was commanded.

62 But these are likened to them neither in appearances nor in powers.

63 From this they must neither be considered nor called gods, since they are able neither to judge a judgment nor to do good to people.

64 Therefore, knowing that they are not gods, do not fear them.

65 For neither shall they curse kings nor bless them.

66 And they shall certainly not show signs among nations in heaven, nor shine like the sun nor illuminate like the moon.

67 The beasts are better than they, which can benefit themselves by fleeing into shelter.

68 Therefore in no manner is it manifest to us that they are gods; therefore do not fear them.

69 For just as a scarecrow in a cucumber bed guards nothing, so are their wooden and gold-overlaid and silver-overlaid gods.

70 In the same manner also their wooden and gold-overlaid and silver-overlaid gods are likened to a thorn bush in a garden upon which every bird sits, and likewise also to a dead person cast in darkness.

71 And from the purple and the marble upon them which decays you will know that they are not gods; and they themselves afterward will be eaten away, and there will be reproach in the country.

72 Therefore a righteous person who has no idols is better, for he will be far from reproach.

Ezekiel

Chapter 1

1 And it happened in the thirtieth year, in the fourth month, on the fifth of the month, and I was amid the captivity by the river Chobar, and the heavens were opened, and I saw visions of God;

2 on the fifth of the month [this was the fifth year of the captivity of king Ioakim]

3 and the word of the Lord came to Iezekiel son of Bouzi, the priest, in the land of the Chaldeans by the river Chobar; and the hand of the Lord came upon me,

4 and I saw, and behold, a lifting wind was coming from the north, and a great cloud in it, and radiance around it and flashing fire, and in its midst like the appearance of electrum amid the fire, and radiance in it.

5 And in the midst was as the likeness of four living creatures; and this was their appearance: a human likeness upon them,

6 and four faces to each, and four wings to each.

7 And their legs were straight, and their feet winged, and sparks like flashing bronze, and their wings light.

8 And a human hand beneath their wings upon their four sides; and the faces of the four of them

9 did not turn when they walked; each went facing their face.

10 And the likeness of their faces: a human face and a lion's face on the right for the four, and a calf's face on the left for the four, and an eagle's face for the four.

11 And their wings were stretched upward for the four, for each two joined to one another, and two covered over their body.

12 And each went facing its face; wherever the spirit went, they went and did not turn.

13 And amid the living creatures an appearance like burning coals of fire, like the sight of torches whirling among the living creatures, and radiance of fire, and lightning went out from the fire.

15 And I saw, and behold, one wheel upon the earth adjoining the living creatures, for the four;

16 and the form of the wheels like the form of tharsis, and one likeness for the four, and their workmanship was as though a wheel were within a wheel.

17 They went upon their four sides; they did not turn as they went,

18 nor did their backs, and they had height; and I saw them, and their backs were full of eyes round about, for the four.

19 And when the living creatures went, the wheels went adjoining them, and when the living creatures rose from the earth, the wheels rose.

20 Wherever the cloud was, there was the spirit of going; the living creatures and the wheels went and rose with them, because a spirit of life was in the wheels.

21 When they went, they went, and when they stood, they stood, and when they rose from the earth, they rose with them, because a spirit of life was in the wheels.

22 And a likeness above the head of the living creatures, as a firmament like the appearance of crystal, stretched over their wings above;

23 and beneath the firmament their wings were stretched, fluttering one against another, two joined for each, covering their bodies.

24 And I heard the sound of their wings as they went, like the sound of much water; and when they stood, their wings ceased.

25 And behold, a voice above the firmament which was above their head.

26 Like the appearance of a sapphire stone, a likeness of a throne upon it, and upon the likeness of the throne a likeness as the form of a person above.

27 And I saw as the sight of electrum from the appearance of the waist and upward, and from the appearance of the waist downward I saw as the appearance of fire and its radiance round about.

28 Like the appearance of a bow when it is in the cloud on a day of rain, so was the standing of the radiance round about. This was the appearance of the likeness of the Lord's glory; and I saw and fall upon my face and heard the voice of one speaking.

Chapter 2

1 And he said to me, Son of man, stand upon your feet, and I will speak to you.

2 And a spirit came upon me and took me up and raised me and stood me upon my feet, and I heard him speaking to me,

3 and he said to me, Son of man, I send you out to the house of Israel, those provoking me to bitterness, who provoked me to bitterness, they and their fathers, until this day,

4 and you shall say to them, Thus says the Lord,

5 Whether indeed they hear or are terrified — because it is a house provoking to bitterness — and they will know that you are a prophet in their midst.

6 And you, son of man, do not fear them nor be dismayed before their face, because they will rage and gather against you round about, and you dwell amid scorpions; do not fear their words and do not be dismayed before their face, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

7 And you shall speak my words to them, whether indeed they hear or are terrified, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

8 And you, son of man, hear him who speaks to you; do not become one provoking to bitterness like the house provoking to bitterness; open your mouth wide and eat what I give you.

9 And I saw, and behold, a hand stretched toward me, and in it a scroll of a book;

10 and he unrolled it before me, and in it were things written on the back and on the front, and upon it were written lament and song and woe.

Chapter 3

1 And he said to me, Son of man, devour this scroll and go and speak to the sons of Israel.

2 And I opened my mouth wide, and he fed me the scroll.

3 And he said to me, Son of man, your mouth shall eat, and your belly shall be filled with this scroll given to you. And I ate it, and it became in my mouth like sweet honey.

4 And he said to me, Son of man, go, enter the house of Israel and speak my words to them;

5 because you are not sent out to a people deep of lip and heavy of tongue, to the house of Israel,

6 nor to many peoples of another voice or another tongue, nor to those weighty in tongue, whose words you will not understand; and if I had sent you out to such ones, these would have heard you.

7 But the house of Israel will certainly not wish to hear you, because they do not wish to hear me; because all the house of Israel are contentious and hardhearted.

8 And behold, I have made your face strong before their faces, and I will strengthen your contention against their contention,

9 and it will be continually stronger than rock; do not fear them nor be terrified before their face, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

10 And he said to me, Son of man, all the words which I have spoken with you, receive into your heart and hear with your ears,

11 and go, enter the captivity, to the sons of your people, and you shall speak to them and say to them, Thus says the Lord, whether indeed they hear, whether indeed they yield.

12 And a spirit took me up, and I heard behind me a sound of a great shaking: Blessed is the glory of the Lord from his place.

13 And I saw the sound of the wings of the living creatures fluttering one against another, and the sound of the wheels adjoining them and the sound of the shaking.

14 And the spirit raised me and took me up, and I went in the impulse of my spirit, and the hand of the Lord became mighty upon me.

15 And I entered the captivity aloft and went round those dwelling by the river Chobar, those who were there, and sat there seven days moving about in their midst.

16 And it happened after the seven days, the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

17 Son of man, I have made you a watchman for the house of Israel, and you shall hear a word from my mouth and warn them from me.

18 When I say to the lawless one, By death you shall be put to death, and you did not warn him nor speak to warn the lawless one to turn from his ways that he might live, that lawless one will die in his injustice, and I will require his blood from your hand.

19 And if you warn the lawless one, and he does not turn from his lawlessness and his way, that lawless one will die in his injustice, and you will rescue your soul.

20 And when a righteous one turns from his righteous deeds and commits a transgression, and I give torment before his face, he will die, because you did not warn him, and he will die in his sins, because his righteous deeds which he did shall certainly not be remembered, and I will require his blood from your hand.

21 But if you warn the righteous one not to sin, and he does not sin, the righteous one will live with life, because you warned him, and you will rescue your own soul.

22 And the hand of the Lord came upon me, and he said to me, Rise and go out to the plain, and there speech will be made to you.

23 And I rose and went out to the plain, and behold, there the glory of the Lord stood, like the vision and like the glory which I saw by the river Chobar, and I fall upon my face.

24 And a spirit came upon me and stood me upon my feet, and spoke to me and said to me, Enter and be shut up amid your house.

25 And you, son of man, behold, bonds have been given upon you, and they will bind you in them, and you shall certainly not go out from their midst.

26 And I will bind your tongue, and you will be made mute and will not be to them a man reproving, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

27 And when I speak to you, I will open your mouth, and you shall say to them, Thus says the Lord, Let him who hears hear, and let him who disobeys disobey, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

Chapter 4

1 And you, son of man, take a brick for yourself and place it before your face and draw upon it the city Ierusalem,

2 and set a siege against it and build outworks against it and cast a rampart against it and set camps against it and arrange the missile stations round about;

3 and take an iron pan for yourself and place it as an iron wall between you and the city and prepare your face against it, and it shall be under confinement, and you shall confine it; this is a sign for the sons of Israel. —

4 And you shall lie upon your left side and place the injustices of the house of Israel upon it, according to the number of the days, a hundred and fifty, which you shall lie upon it, and bear their injustices.

5 And I have given you their two injustices for a number of days, a hundred and ninety days. And you shall bear the injustices of the house of Israel

6 and complete all these things; and you shall lie upon your right side and bear the injustices of the house of Iouda forty days. I have appointed you a day for a year.

7 And for the confinement of Ierusalem you shall prepare your face and make your arm firm and prophesy against it.

8 And behold, I have given bonds upon you, and do not turn from your side onto your side until the days of your confinement are completed. —

9 And take for yourself wheat and barley and beans and lentils and millet and spelt and put them into one earthen vessel and make them into bread for yourself, and according to the number of the days which you sleep upon your side, a hundred and ninety days, you shall eat them.

10 And your food which you shall eat shall be by weight, twenty shekels a day; from time to time you shall eat them.

11 And you shall drink water by measure, the sixth of a hin; from time to time you shall drink.

12 And you shall eat them as a barley cake baked in ashes; in lumps of human dung you shall bake them before their eyes

13 and say, Thus says the Lord, the God of Israel, Thus shall the sons of Israel eat unclean things among the nations.

14 And I said, By no means, Lord God of Israel; behold, my soul has not been defiled in uncleanness, and I have not eaten anything dead of itself or taken by beasts from my birth until now, nor has any stale meat entered my mouth.

15 And he said to me, Behold, I have given you cow dung instead of human dung, and you shall make your bread upon it.

16 And he said to me, Son of man, behold, I break the support of bread in Ierusalem, and they shall eat bread by weight and in want and drink water by measure and in destruction,

17 so that they become wanting bread and water; and a person and his brother will be destroyed and waste away in their injustices. —

Chapter 5

1 And you, son of man, take for yourself a sword sharper than a barber's razor; acquire it for yourself and bring it upon your head and upon your beard. And take a balance of weights and divide them;

2 a fourth you shall burn with fire amid the city at the completion of the days of confinement; and take a fourth and burn it up in its midst; and a fourth you shall cut with a sword round about it; and a fourth you shall scatter to the wind, and I will draw a sword behind them.

3 And take from there a few in number and gather them in your mantle.

4 And from these take yet more and throw them into the midst of the fire and burn them up with fire; from it fire will go out. And you shall say to all the house of Israel,

5 Thus says the Lord, This is Ierusalem; I have placed her amid the nations and the countries round about her.

6 And you shall speak my just requirements to the lawless woman from the nations and my statutes from the countries round about her, because they rejected my just requirements and did not walk in my statutes, in them.

7 Therefore thus says the Lord, Because your impulse is from the nations round about you and you did not walk in my statutes and did not do my just requirements, but neither have you acted according to the just requirements of the nations round about you,

8 therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, I am against you and will execute judgment in your midst before the nations

9 and do in you what I have not done and what I will not do the like of again, according to all your abominations.

10 Therefore fathers shall eat children in your midst, and children shall eat fathers; and I will execute judgments in you and scatter all your remnants to every wind.

11 Therefore, I live, says the Lord, surely because you defiled my holy things with all your abominations, I too will reject you; my eye will not spare, and I too will not have mercy.

12 A fourth of you will be consumed in death; and a fourth of you will be brought to an end in famine in your midst; and a fourth of you I will scatter them to every wind; and a fourth of you will fall by sword round about you, and I will draw a sword behind them.

13 And my wrath and my anger against them will be completed, and you will recognize that I the Lord have spoken in my zeal when I complete my anger against them.

14 And I will make you a wilderness and your daughters round about you before everyone passing through,

15 and you will be lamented and wretched among the nations round about you when I execute judgments in you in the vengeance of my wrath; I the Lord have spoken.

16 When I send out my missiles of famine upon them, and they will be for failure, and I will break your support of bread.

17 And I will send out famine and evil beasts against you and punish you, and death and blood will pass over you, and I will bring a sword against you round about; I the Lord have spoken.

Chapter 6

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, set your face against the mountains of Israel and prophesy against them

3 and say, Mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord: Thus says the Lord to the mountains and the hills and the ravines and the valleys, Behold, I bring a sword upon you, and your high places will be destroyed,

4 and your altars and your precincts will be crushed, and I will cast down your wounded before your idols

5 and scatter your bones round about your altars.

6 In all your habitation the cities will be made desolate and the high places destroyed, so that your altars may be destroyed, and your idols will be crushed and your precincts removed,

7 and wounded ones will fall in your midst, and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

8 When there are among you those escaping from sword among the nations and in your scattering in the countries,

9 and those escaping among you will remember me among the nations where they were taken captive there; I have sworn against their heart which prostitutes itself away from me and against their eyes which prostitute themselves after their practices, and they will beat their faces for all their abominations;

10 and they will recognize that I the Lord have spoken.

11 Thus says the Lord, Clap with the hand and stamp with the foot and say, Well done, well done, over all the abominations of the house of Israel; by sword and by death and by famine they will fall.

12 The one near will fall by sword, and the one far away will end in death, and the one enclosed will be brought to an end in famine, and I will complete my anger against them.

13 And you will know that I am the Lord when your wounded are amid your idols round about your altars, upon every high hill and beneath a shady tree, where they gave there a fragrant smell to all their idols.

14 And I will stretch my hand against them and make the land destruction and ruin, from the wilderness Deblatha, from all the habitation; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

Chapter 7

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 And you, son of man, say, Thus says the Lord to the land of Israel, An end has come, the end has come upon the four wings of the earth;

3 the end has come

4 upon you who inhabit the land; the time has come, the day has drawn near, not with tumults nor with birth pangs.

5 Now from nearby I will pour out my anger upon you and complete my wrath in you and judge you in your ways and bring all your abominations upon you;

6 my eye will not spare, nor shall I have mercy, because I will bring your ways upon you, and your abominations will be in your midst, and you will recognize that I am the Lord who strikes.

7 Now the end is against you, and I will send against you and punish you in your ways and bring all your abominations upon you;

8 my eye will not spare you, nor shall I have mercy, because I will bring your way upon you, and your abominations will be in your midst; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

9 Because thus says the Lord,

10 Behold, the end has come, behold, the day of the Lord; even if the rod has blossomed, insolence has risen up.

11 And he will break the support of a lawless one, and not with tumult nor with haste.

12 The time has come, behold, the day; let the buyer not rejoice, and let the seller not lament;

13 because the buyer shall no longer return to the seller, and a person will not prevail in the eye of his life.

14 Blow with a trumpet and judge all things together.

15 War with sword outside, and famine and death within; the one in the plain will end by sword, but those in the city famine and death will bring to an end.

16 And those escaping among them will escape and be upon the mountains; I will kill all, each in his injustices.

17 All hands will grow faint, and all thighs will be defiled with moisture,

18 and they will gird themselves with sackcloth, and amazement will cover them, and upon every face shame will be upon them, and upon every head baldness.

19 Their silver will be thrown in the squares, and their gold will be disregarded; their souls shall certainly not be filled, and their bellies shall certainly not be filled; because it became a torment of their injustices.

20 Choice ornaments they made into pride, and images of their abominations they made from them; for this reason I have given them to them for uncleanness.

21 And I will hand them into the hands of foreigners to plunder them and to the pests of the earth as spoils, and they will profane them.

22 And I will turn my face away from them, and they will defile my oversight and enter them without guard and profane them;

23 and they will make a confusion, because the land is full of peoples and the city full of lawlessness.

24 And I will turn away the arrogance of their strength, and their holy things will be defiled.

25 Expiation will come and seek peace, and there will be none.

26 Woe upon woe will be, and report upon report will be, and a vision will be sought from a prophet, and law will perish from a priest and counsel from elders.

27 A ruler will clothe himself in destruction, and the hands of the people of the land will be paralyzed; according to their ways I will deal with them and in their judgments punish them; and they will know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 8

1 And it happened in the sixth year, in the fifth month, on the fifth of the month, I sat in the house, and the elders of Iouda sat before me, and the hand of the Lord came upon me,

2 and I saw, and behold, a likeness of a man, from his waist downward fire, and from his waist upward like the appearance of electrum.

3 And he stretched a likeness of a hand and took me by my crown, and a spirit took me up between earth and heaven and brought me to Ierusalem in a vision of God, to the entrance of the inner gate facing north, where was the pillar of the possessor.

4 And behold, there was the glory of the Lord God of Israel, according to the vision which I saw in the plain.

5 And he said to me, Son of man, look up with your eyes toward the north; and I looked up with my eyes toward the north, and behold, from the north to the gate toward the east.

6 And he said to me, Son of man, have you seen what these do? They do great lawless deeds here, to keep away from my holy things; and you will yet see greater lawless deeds.

7 And he brought me to the entrance of the court

8 and said to me, Son of man, dig; and I dug, and behold, one door.

9 And he said to me, Enter and see the lawless deeds which these do here;

10 and I entered and saw, and behold, vain abominations and all the idols of the house of Israel drawn upon it round about,

11 and seventy men from the elders of the house of Israel, and Iezonias son of Saphan stood amid them before their face, and each held his incense burner in the hand, and the vapor of the incense rose.

12 And he said to me, Son of man, have you seen what the elders of the house of Israel do, each of them in their hidden chamber? Because they said, The Lord does not see, the Lord has abandoned the land.

13 And he said to me, You will yet see greater lawless deeds which these do.

14 And he brought me to the entrance of the gate of the Lord's house facing north, and behold, there women sat lamenting Thammouz,

15 and he said to me, Son of man, have you seen? And you will yet see practices greater than these.

16 And he brought me into the inner court of the Lord's house, and behold, at the entrance of the Lord's temple, between the ailam and the altar, about twenty men, their backs toward the Lord's temple and their faces opposite, and these worship the sun;

17 and he said to me, Have you seen, son of man? Is it a small thing for the house of Iouda to do the lawless deeds which they have done here? Because they filled the land with lawlessness, and behold, they are as ones sneering.

18 And I will deal with them in wrath; my eye will not spare, nor shall I have mercy.

Chapter 9

1 And he cried into my ears with a great voice, saying, The vengeance of the city has drawn near; and each held the instruments of destruction in his hand.

2 And behold, six men were coming from the way of the high gate facing north, and each had an axe in his hand; and one man amid them clothed in a robe reaching the feet, and a sapphire girdle upon his waist; and they entered and stood adjoining the bronze altar.

3 And the glory of the God of Israel, which was upon them, rose from the cheroubin to the open court of the house. And he called the man clothed in the robe reaching the feet, who had the girdle upon his waist,

4 and said to him, Pass through the midst of Ierusalem and put the sign upon the foreheads of the men who groan and suffer over all the lawless deeds being done in her midst.

5 And to these he said in my hearing, Go after him into the city and strike, and do not spare with your eyes and do not have mercy;

6 kill elder and young man and maiden and infants and women unto obliteration, but do not draw near to any upon whom is the sign; and begin from my holy things. And they began from the elderly men who were within the house.

7 And he said to them, Defile the house and fill the roads with dead ones, going out, and strike.

8 And it happened as they struck, and I fall upon my face and cried out and said, Alas for me, Lord, are you obliterating the remnants of Israel when you pour out your wrath upon Ierusalem?

9 And he said to me, The injustice of the house of Israel and Iouda has grown exceedingly, exceedingly great, because the land was filled with many peoples, and the city was filled with injustice and uncleanness; because they said, The Lord has abandoned the land, the Lord does not look upon it.

10 And my eye will not spare, nor shall I have mercy; I have brought their ways upon their heads.

11 And behold, the man clothed in the robe reaching the feet and girded with the girdle about his waist, and he answered, saying, I have done as you commanded me.

Chapter 10

1 And I saw, and behold, above the firmament over the head of the cheroubin, like a sapphire stone, a likeness of a throne upon them.

2 And he said to the man clothed in the robe, Enter amid the wheels beneath the cheroubin and fill your handfuls with coals of fire from amid the cheroubin and scatter them upon the city; and he entered before me.

3 And the cheroubin stood on the right of the house as the man entered, and the cloud filled the inner court.

4 And the glory of the Lord rose from the cheroubin to the open court of the house, and the cloud filled the house, and the court was filled with the radiance of the Lord's glory;

5 and the sound of the wings of the cheroubin was heard as far as the outer court, like the voice of God Saddai speaking.

6 And it happened when he commanded the man clothed in the holy robe, saying, Take fire from amid the wheels, from amid the cheroubin, and he entered and stood adjoining the wheels,

7 and he stretched his hand into the midst of the fire which was amid the cheroubin and took and gave into the hands of him clothed in the holy robe, and he took and went out.

8 And I saw the cheroubin, a likeness of human hands beneath their wings.

9 And I saw, and behold, four wheels stood adjoining the cheroubin, one wheel adjoining one cheroub, and the appearance of the wheels like the appearance of a carbuncle stone.

10 And their appearance was one likeness for the four, as when a wheel is amid a wheel.

11 As they went, they went toward their four sides; they did not turn as they went, because toward whatever place the one leading part looked, they went and did not turn as they went.

12 And their backs and their hands and their wings and the wheels were full of eyes round about, for their four wheels;

13 and these wheels were called Gelgel in my hearing;

15 and the cheroubin rose. This is the living creature which I saw by the river Chobar.

16 And when the cheroubin went, the wheels went, and these adjoined them; and when the cheroubin raised their wings to rise aloft from the earth, their wheels did not turn;

17 when they stood, they stood, and when they rose aloft, they rose aloft with them, because a spirit of life was in them.

18 And the glory of the Lord went out from the house and mounted upon the cheroubin,

19 and the cheroubin took up their wings and rose aloft from the earth before me as they went out, and the wheels adjoined them, and they stood at the entrance of the opposite gate of the Lord's house, and the glory of the God of Israel was above upon them.

20 This is the living creature which I saw beneath the God of Israel by the river Chobar, and I knew that they are cheroubin.

21 Four faces to each, and eight wings to each, and a likeness of human hands beneath their wings.

22 And the likeness of their faces, these are the faces which I saw beneath the glory of the God of Israel by the river Chobar, and each of them went facing their face.

Chapter 11

1 And a spirit took me up and brought me to the opposite gate of the Lord's house, facing east; and behold, at the entrance of the gate about twenty-five men, and I saw amid them Iezonias son of Ezer and Phaltias son of Banaias, the leaders of the people.

2 And the Lord said to me, Son of man, these are the men who devise vain things and plan an evil plan in this city,

3 who say, Have not the houses been built recently? This is the pot, and we the meat.

4 Therefore prophesy against them, prophesy, son of man.

5 And the spirit of the Lord fell upon me and said to me, Say, Thus says the Lord, Thus you said, house of Israel, and I know the designs of your spirit.

6 You multiplied your dead in this city and filled her roads with wounded ones.

7 Therefore thus says the Lord, Your dead whom you struck in her midst, these are the meat, and she is the pot, and I will bring you out from her midst.

8 You fear a sword, and I will bring a sword upon you, says the Lord.

9 And I will bring you out from her midst and hand you into the hands of foreigners and execute judgments among you.

10 You will fall by sword; upon the borders of Israel I will judge you; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

11 She will not be a pot for you, and you shall certainly not become meat in her midst; upon the borders of Israel I will judge you,

12 and you will recognize that I am the Lord. —

13 And it happened as I prophesied, and Phaltias son of Banaias died, and I fall upon my face and cried with a great voice and said, Alas, alas, Lord, you are bringing the remnants of Israel to an end.

14 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

15 Son of man, your brothers and the men of your captivity and all the house of Israel have been brought to an end, to whom those dwelling in Ierusalem said, Keep far away from the Lord; to us the land has been given for an inheritance.

16 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, I will thrust them away into the nations and scatter them into all the earth, and I will be a small sanctuary for them in the countries where they enter there.

17 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, And I will receive them from the nations and gather them from the countries where I scattered them in them, and give them the land of Israel.

18 And they will enter there and remove all her abominations and all her lawless deeds from her.

19 And I will give them another heart and put a new spirit in them and tear the stone heart out of their flesh and give them a heart of flesh,

20 so that they walk in my ordinances and keep my just requirements and do them; and they shall be a people to me, and I shall be God to them.

21 And toward the heart of their abominations and their lawless deeds, as their heart went, I have brought their ways upon their heads, says the Lord.

22 And the cheroubin raised their wings, and the wheels adjoined them, and the glory of the God of Israel was upon them above them;

23 and the glory of the Lord rose from amid the city and stood upon the mountain which was opposite the city.

24 And a spirit took me up and brought me to the land of the Chaldeans, to the captivity, in a vision, in the spirit of God; and I rose from the vision which I saw,

25 and spoke to the captivity all the words of the Lord which he showed me.

Chapter 12

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, you dwell amid their injustices, who have eyes to see and do not see and have ears to hear and do not hear, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

3 And you, son of man, prepare for yourself the baggage of captivity by day before them and go into captivity from your place to another place before them, so that they may see, because it is a house provoking to bitterness.

4 And you shall bring out your baggage as baggage of captivity by day before their eyes, and you shall go out in the evening as a captive goes out;

5 before them dig through the wall for yourself and pass out through it;

6 before them you shall be taken up upon shoulders and go out hidden; you shall cover your face and certainly not see the land; because I have made you a portent for the house of Israel.

7 And I did thus according to all that he commanded me, and brought out baggage as baggage of captivity by day and in the evening dug through the wall for myself and went out hidden; I was taken up upon shoulders before them. —

8 And the word of the Lord came to me in the morning, saying,

9 Son of man, did not the house of Israel, the house provoking to bitterness, say to you, What are you doing?

10 Say to them, Thus says the Lord Lord, The ruler and the leader in Ierusalem and all the house of Israel who are in their midst,

11 say that I perform portents in her midst; as I have done, so it will be for them; they will go in removal and in captivity,

12 and the ruler in their midst will be lifted upon shoulders and go out hidden through the wall, and he will dig through to go out through it; he will cover his face so that he may not be seen by an eye, and he himself will not see the land.

13 And I will spread my net over him, and he will be captured in my enclosure, and I will bring him to Babylon, to the land of the Chaldeans, and he will not see it and will end there.

14 And all those round about him, his helpers and all who support him, I will scatter to every wind and draw a sword behind them;

15 and they will know that I am the Lord when I scatter them among the nations, and I will scatter them in the countries.

16 And I will leave among them men few in number from sword and famine and death, so that they recount all their lawless deeds among the nations where they entered there; and they will know that I am the Lord. —

17 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

18 Son of man, you shall eat your bread with pain and drink your water with torment and affliction

19 and say to the people of the land, Thus says the Lord to those dwelling in Ierusalem upon the land of Israel, They will eat their bread with want and drink their water with destruction, so that the land with its fullness may be destroyed, for all who dwell in it are in impiety;

20 and their inhabited cities will be made desolate, and the land will be for destruction; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

21 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

22 Son of man, what is this proverb of yours upon the land of Israel, saying, The days are far away, a vision has perished?

23 Therefore say to them, Thus says the Lord, I will turn away this proverb, and the house of Israel shall no longer say this proverb, because you shall speak to them, The days and the word of every vision have drawn near;

24 because there will no longer be any false vision and one divining pleasing things amid the sons of Israel,

25 because I the Lord will speak my words, I will speak and do and certainly not delay any longer, because in your days, house provoking to bitterness, I will speak a word and do it, says the Lord. —

26 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

27 Son of man, behold, the house of Israel provoking to bitterness, saying, they say, The vision which this one sees is for many days, and this one prophesies for distant times.

28 Therefore say to them, Thus says the Lord, All my words which I speak shall certainly no longer be delayed; I will speak and do, says the Lord.

Chapter 13

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel, and you shall prophesy and say to them, Hear the word of the Lord,

3 Thus says the Lord, Woe to those prophesying from their heart and seeing nothing at all.

4 Your prophets, Israel, are like foxes in the wildernesses;

5 they did not stand in a firm position and gathered flocks against the house of Israel; those saying, On the day of the Lord, did not rise;

6 seeing false things, divining vain things, those saying, The Lord says, and the Lord has not sent them, and they began to establish a word.

7 Have you not seen a false vision and spoken vain divinations?

8 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, Because your words are false and your divinations vain, therefore behold, I am against you, says the Lord,

9 and I will stretch my hand against the prophets who see false things and utter vain things; they will not be in the discipline of my people nor be inscribed in the register of the house of Israel, and they will not enter the land of Israel; and they will know that I am the Lord.

10 Because they misled my people, saying, Peace, peace, and there was no peace, and this one builds a wall, and they plaster it, whether it will fall,

11 say to those plastering, It will fall, and there will be flooding rain, and I will put stones for hurling against their joints, and they will fall, and a lifting wind, and it will be torn apart.

12 And behold, the wall has fallen, and will they not say to you, Where is your plaster which you plastered?

13 Therefore thus says the Lord, And I will break forth a lifting blast with wrath, and flooding rain will be in my anger, and I will bring the stones for hurling in wrath unto an end

14 and tear down the wall which you plastered, and it will fall; and I will lay it upon the earth, and its foundations will be uncovered, and it will fall, and you will be brought to an end with reproofs; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

15 And I will complete my wrath against the wall and against those plastering it, and it will fall. And I said to you, There is no wall nor those plastering it,

16 prophets of Israel who prophesy concerning Ierusalem and who see peace for her, and there is no peace, says the Lord. —

17 And you, son of man, set your face against the daughters of your people who prophesy from their heart and prophesy against them

18 and say, Thus says the Lord, Woe to those sewing cushions upon every elbow of an arm and making coverings upon every head of every age, to pervert souls; the souls of my people were perverted, and they preserved souls.

19 And they profaned me toward my people for a handful of barley and for fragments of bread, to kill souls which ought not to die and to preserve souls which ought not to live, when you utter things to a people who hear vain utterances.

20 Therefore thus says the Lord Lord, Behold, I am against your cushions upon which you entangle souls there, and I will tear them from your arms and send out the souls whose souls you pervert, into scattering;

21 and I will tear your coverings and rescue my people from your hand, and they will no longer be in your hands for entanglement; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

22 Because you perverted the heart of a righteous one unjustly, and I did not pervert him, and strengthened the hands of a lawless one so that he should not at all turn from his evil way and live,

23 therefore you shall certainly not see false things nor divine divinations any longer, and I will rescue my people from your hand; and you will know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 14

1 And men from the elders of Israel came to me and sat before my face.

2 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

3 Son of man, these men placed their thoughts upon their hearts and set the punishment of their injustices before their face; shall I, answering, answer them?

4 Therefore speak to them and say to them, Thus says the Lord, Any person from the house of Israel who places his thoughts upon his heart and sets the punishment of his injustice before his face and comes to the prophet, I the Lord will answer him in the things in which his thought is entangled,

5 so that he turn the house of Israel aside according to their hearts alienated from me in their thoughts.

6 Therefore say to the house of Israel, Thus says the Lord Lord, Return and turn away from your practices and from all your impieties and turn your faces.

7 Because any person from the house of Israel and from the sojourners sojourning in Israel who is alienated from me and places his thoughts upon his heart and sets the punishment of his injustice before his face and comes to the prophet to inquire of him concerning me, I the Lord will answer him in that in which he is entangled in it;

8 and I will set my face against that person and make him a wilderness and destruction and remove him from amid my people; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

9 And if the prophet is misled and speaks, I the Lord have misled that prophet and will stretch my hand against him and destroy him from amid my people Israel.

10 And they will bear their injustice; according to the wrong of the inquirer and according to the wrong, likewise it will be for the prophet,

11 so that the house of Israel may no longer stray from me, and that they may no longer be defiled in all their transgressions; and they shall be a people to me, and I shall be God to them, says the Lord.

12 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

13 Son of man, if a land sins against me by committing a transgression, and I stretch my hand against it and break its support of bread and send out famine upon it and remove human and beasts from it,

14 and if these three men are in its midst, Noe and Daniel and Iob, they will be saved in their righteousness, says the Lord.

15 And if I bring evil beasts upon the land and punish it and it becomes destruction and there is none passing through from the face of the beasts,

16 and these three men are in its midst, I live, says the Lord, no sons or daughters will be saved, but they alone will be saved, and the land will become ruin.

17 Or also if I bring a sword upon that land and say, Let a sword pass through the land, and I remove human and beast from it,

18 and these three men are in its midst, I live, says the Lord, they shall certainly not rescue sons nor daughters; they alone will be saved.

19 Or also if I send death upon that land and pour out my wrath upon it in blood, to destroy human and beast from it,

20 and Noe and Daniel and Iob are in its midst, I live, says the Lord, no sons or daughters shall be left; they in their righteousness will rescue their souls.

21 Thus says the Lord, But if I also send out my four evil acts of vengeance, sword and famine and evil beasts and death, upon Ierusalem, to destroy human and beast from her,

22 and behold, left in her are her survivors who bring sons and daughters out of her, behold, they go out to you, and you will see their ways and their thoughts and change your mind concerning the evils which I brought upon Ierusalem, all the evils which I brought upon her,

23 and they will comfort you, because you will see their ways and their thoughts and recognize that I have not done in vain all that I did in her, says the Lord.

Chapter 15

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 And you, son of man, what could the wood of the vine become, among all the wood of the branches which are among the trees of the forest?

3 Will they take wood from it to make it into workmanship? Will they take a peg from it to hang any vessel upon it?

4 Except that it has been given to fire for consumption; the yearly pruning from it the fire consumes, and it fails utterly; will it be useful for workmanship?

5 Not even while it is still whole will it be for workmanship. Much less, if fire also consumes it utterly, will it still be for workmanship?

6 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, As the wood of the vine among the trees of the forest, which I have given to fire for consumption, so I have given those dwelling in Ierusalem.

7 And I will set my face against them; they will go out from fire, and fire will devour them, and they will recognize that I am the Lord when I set my face against them.

8 And I will give the land to destruction because they committed a transgression, says the Lord.

Chapter 16

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, testify to Ierusalem concerning her lawless deeds

3 and say, Thus says the Lord to Ierusalem, Your root and your birth are from the land of Chanaan; your father an Amorrite, and your mother a Chettaia.

4 And your birth: on the day when you were born, they did not bind your breasts, and you were not washed in water nor salted with salt nor wrapped in swaddling clothes,

5 nor did my eye spare you, to do one of all these things for you, to feel anything for you, and you were cast upon the face of the plain in the crookedness of your soul on the day when you were born.

6 And I passed by you and saw you smeared in your blood and said to you, From your blood, life;

7 multiply; like the sprouting of the field I have made you. And you multiplied and grew great and entered cities of cities; your breasts were raised, and your hair grew, but you were naked and indecent.

8 And I passed through you and saw you, and behold, your time was a time of those lodging, and I spread my wings over you and covered your indecency; and I swore to you and entered into a covenant with you, says the Lord, and you became mine.

9 And I washed you in water and washed your blood off you and anointed you with oil

10 and clothed you in embroidered things and shod you in blue and girded you with fine linen and wrapped you in woven hair,

11 and adorned you with adornment and placed bracelets around your hands and a necklace around your neck,

12 and put a ring around your nostril and little rings upon your ears and a crown of boasting upon your head;

13 and you were adorned with gold and silver, and your coverings were fine linen and woven hair and embroidery; you ate fine flour and oil and honey and became exceedingly beautiful.

14 And your name went out among the nations in your beauty, because it was perfected in comeliness, in the beauty which I set upon you, says the Lord. —

15 And you trusted in your beauty and prostituted yourself on account of your name and poured out your prostitution upon every passerby, which shall not be.

16 And you took from your garments and made sewn idols for yourself and prostituted yourself upon them; and you shall certainly not enter, nor shall it happen.

17 And you took the vessels of your boasting from my gold and from my silver, from what I gave you, and made male images for yourself and prostituted yourself with them;

18 and you took your embroidered apparel and clothed them, and my oil and my incense you placed before their face;

19 and my bread which I gave you — fine flour and oil and honey I fed you — and you placed them before their face for a fragrant smell; and it happened, says the Lord.

20 And you took your sons and your daughters whom you bore and sacrificed them to them for consumption, as though your prostitution were a small thing,

21 and slaughtered your children and gave them when you performed rites of aversion with them.

22 This beyond all your prostitution, and you did not remember the days of your infancy, when you were naked and indecent and lived smeared in your blood.

23 And it happened after all your wickedness, says the Lord,

24 and you built yourself a house of prostitution and made yourself an exposed place in every square,

25 and at the beginning of every road you built your brothels and ruined your beauty and spread your legs for every passerby and multiplied your prostitution;

26 and you prostituted yourself with the sons of Egypt, your neighbors, great of flesh, and prostituted yourself in many ways to provoke me to anger.

27 But if I stretch my hand against you, and I will remove your statutes and hand you over to the desires of those who hate you, daughters of foreigners who turn you aside from your way in which you acted impiously.

28 And you prostituted yourself with the daughters of Assour and were not filled even thus; and you prostituted yourself and were not filled.

29 And you multiplied your covenants toward the land of the Chaldeans and were not filled even with these.

30 How shall I deal with your daughter, says the Lord, when you do all these things, works of a prostitute woman? And you prostituted yourself threefold

31 in your daughters; you built your brothel at every beginning of a road and made your platform in every square and became like a prostitute gathering wages.

32 The adulterous woman is like you, receiving wages from her husband;

33 she gave wages to all who prostituted her, and you have given wages to all your lovers and loaded them with gifts to come to you from round about in your prostitution.

34 And in you it became reversed in comparison with women in your prostitution, and they have prostituted themselves with you when you gave wages, and wages were not given to you, and in you things became reversed. —

35 Therefore, prostitute, hear the word of the Lord,

36 Thus says the Lord, Because you poured out your bronze, and your shame will be uncovered in your prostitution toward your lovers and in all the thoughts of your lawless deeds and in the blood of your children whom you gave them.

37 Therefore behold, I gather all your lovers against you, with whom you mingled among them, and all whom you loved, with all whom you hated; and I will gather them against you round about and uncover your wickedness to them, and they will see all your shame;

38 and I will punish you with the punishment of an adulteress and one pouring out blood and place you in blood of wrath and jealousy.

39 And I will hand you into their hands, and they will tear down your brothel and pull down your platform and strip you of your apparel and take the vessels of your boasting and leave you naked and indecent.

40 And they will bring crowds against you and stone you with stones and slaughter you with their swords.

41 And they will burn your houses with fire and execute acts of vengeance in you before many women; and I will turn you away from your prostitution, and you shall certainly no longer give wages.

42 And I will let my wrath loose upon you, and my jealousy will be removed from you, and I will rest and certainly no longer be concerned.

43 Because you did not remember the day of your infancy and grieved me in all these things, and behold, I have brought your ways upon your head, says the Lord; and thus you committed impiety on top of all your lawless deeds.

44 These are all the things which they said against you in a proverb, saying, As the mother, so the daughter.

45 You are a daughter of your mother who rejected her husband and her children, and a sister of your sisters who rejected their husbands and their children; your mother a Chettaia, and your father an Amorrite.

46 Your elder sister is Samareia, she and her daughters, who dwells on your left; and your sister younger than you, who dwells on your right, is Sodoma and her daughters.

47 And not even thus did you walk in their ways nor act according to their lawless deeds; in a little while you surpassed them in all your ways.

48 I live, says the Lord, your sister Sodoma, she and her daughters, has not done as you and your daughters did.

49 But this was the lawless deed of Sodoma your sister: pride; in fullness of bread and abundance of wine she and her daughters lived luxuriously; this belonged to her and her daughters, and they did not support the hand of a poor and needy one.

50 And they boasted greatly and committed lawless deeds before me, and I removed them as I saw.

51 And Samareia did not sin according to half your sins; and you multiplied your lawless deeds beyond them and justified your sisters in all your lawless deeds which you did.

52 And you, bear your torment, in which you corrupted your sisters by your sins in which you acted lawlessly beyond them and justified them beyond yourself; and you, be ashamed and receive your dishonor when you justify your sisters.

53 And I will turn back their reversals, the reversal of Sodoma and her daughters, and turn back the reversal of Samareia and her daughters, and turn back your reversal in their midst,

54 so that you bear your torment and be dishonored for all that you did when you provoked me to anger.

55 And your sister Sodoma and her daughters will be restored as they were from the beginning, and Samareia and her daughters will be restored as they were from the beginning, and you and your daughters will be restored as you were from the beginning.

56 And was not Sodoma your sister a report in your mouth in the days of your pride,

57 before your wickedness was uncovered, as now you are a reproach of daughters of Syria and all those round about her, daughters of foreigners surrounding you round about?

58 Your impieties and your lawless deeds, you have borne them, says the Lord.

59 Thus says the Lord, And I will deal with you as you did, as you dishonored these things by transgressing my covenant.

60 And I will remember my covenant with you in the days of your infancy and establish an everlasting covenant for you.

61 And you will remember your way and be utterly dishonored when you receive your sisters older than you together with those younger than you, and I will give them to you for building up and not from your covenant.

62 And I will establish my covenant with you, and you will recognize that I am the Lord,

63 so that you remember and be ashamed, and it may no longer be yours to open your mouth because of your dishonor, when I make expiation for you for all that you did, says the Lord.

Chapter 17

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, recount a narrative and speak a parable to the house of Israel

3 and say, Thus says the Lord, The great eagle, great of wing, long in span, full of claws, who has the leading role to enter Lebanon, and he took the choice parts of the cedar,

4 he nipped off the tips of the tender growth and brought them to the land of Chanaan, placed them in a walled city.

5 And he took from the seed of the land and placed it in the plain, a plant by much water; he appointed it to be watched over.

6 And it sprouted and became a weak vine and small in size to appear; its branches were upon it, and its roots were beneath it. And it became a vine and made shoots and stretched its climbing growth.

7 And there was another great eagle, great of wing, abundant in claws, and behold, this vine was entwined toward him, and its roots toward him, and it sent out its branches to him to water it with the clod of its planting.

8 In a good plain by much water this one is nourished, to make shoots and bear fruit, to become a great vine.

9 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, Will it prosper? Will not the roots of its tender growth and the fruit rot, and all its early growth dry up? And not with a great arm nor with many people to tear it out from its roots.

10 And behold, it is nourished; will it prosper? Will it not, as soon as the scorching wind touches it, dry up with drying? With the clod of its sprouting it will dry up.

11 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

12 Son of man, say indeed to the house provoking to bitterness, Do you not know what these things were? Say, When the king of Babylon comes against Ierusalem, and he will take her king and her rulers and bring them to himself to Babylon.

13 And he will take from the seed of the kingship and make a covenant with him and bring him under a curse; and he will take the leaders of the land,

14 that it become a weak kingdom, not to be raised at all, to keep his covenant and establish it.

15 And he will revolt from him, to send out his own messengers to Egypt to give him horses and many people. Will he prosper? Will he who does contrary things be saved? And transgressing a covenant, will he be saved?

16 I live, says the Lord, surely in the place of the king who made him king, he who dishonored my curse and transgressed my covenant, with him amid Babylon he will end.

17 And not with great power nor with a great crowd will Pharao make war for him, in casting up a rampart and in building missile stations to take away souls.

18 And he dishonored an oath by transgressing a covenant, and behold, he has given his hand and did all these things to him; will he be saved?

19 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, I live, surely my covenant which he transgressed and my oath which he dishonored, I will bring them upon his head.

20 And I will spread my net over him, and he will be caught in his enclosure.

21 In all his battle array they will fall by sword, and the remnants I will scatter to every wind; and you will recognize that I the Lord have spoken. —

22 Because thus says the Lord, And I will take from the choice parts of the cedar, from the top of their heart I will nip off and I will plant upon a high mountain; and I will hang him

23 on a lofty mountain of Israel and plant, and it will bring out a shoot and make fruit and become a great cedar, and every beast will rest beneath it, and every bird will rest under its shadow; its branches will be restored.

24 And all the trees of the plain will know that I am the Lord who humbles a high tree and raises a low tree and dries a green tree and makes a dry tree flourish; I the Lord have spoken and will do.

Chapter 18

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, what is this proverb of yours among the sons of Israel, saying, The fathers ate unripe grapes, and the children's teeth were set on edge?

3 I live, says the Lord, this proverb shall no longer be spoken in Israel;

4 because all souls are mine; as the father's soul, so also the son's soul, they are mine; the soul that sins, it will die. —

5 But the person who is righteous, doing judgment and righteousness,

6 will not eat upon the mountains and certainly not lift his eyes toward the thoughts of the house of Israel and certainly not defile his neighbor's wife and not approach a woman in menstruation,

7 and certainly not oppress a person, will return a debtor's pledge and does not seize plunder, will give his bread to the hungry and clothe a naked one,

8 and will not give his silver at interest and not take an excess and turn his hand away from injustice, will execute righteous judgment between a man and his neighbor,

9 and has walked in my ordinances and kept my just requirements to do them, this one is righteous, he will live with life, says the Lord. —

10 And if he begets a pestilent son who pours out blood and commits sins,

11 he did not walk in the way of his righteous father, but also ate upon the mountains and defiled his neighbor's wife,

12 and oppressed a poor and needy one and seized plunder and did not return a pledge and set his eyes upon the idols, has committed lawlessness,

13 gave at interest and took an excess, this one will not live with life; he did all these lawless deeds; by death he will be put to death, his blood will be upon him. —

14 But if he begets a son, and he sees all his father's sins which he did, and fears and does not act according to these,

15 has not eaten upon the mountains and did not set his eyes upon the thoughts of the house of Israel and did not defile his neighbor's wife,

16 and did not oppress a person and did not take a pledge and did not seize plunder, gave his bread to the hungry and clothed a naked one,

17 and turned his hand away from injustice, did not take interest nor excess, did righteousness and walked in my ordinances, he will not end in his father's injustices; he will live with life.

18 But his father, if afflicting he afflicts and seizes plunder, did contrary things amid my people and will die in his injustice. —

19 And you will say, Why did the son not bear his father's injustice? Because the son did righteousness and mercy, kept all my statutes and did them; he will live with life.

20 But the soul that sins will die; the son will not bear his father's injustice, nor will the father bear his son's injustice; the righteousness of a righteous one will be upon him, and the lawlessness of a lawless one will be upon him.

21 And if the lawless one turns from all his lawless deeds which he did and keeps all my commandments and does righteousness and mercy, he will live with life, shall certainly not die.

22 All his transgressions which he did will not be remembered; in his righteousness which he did he will live.

23 Would I desire with desire the death of the lawless one, says the Lord, rather than his turning from his evil way and living?

24 But when a righteous one turns from his righteousness and does injustice according to all the lawless deeds which the lawless one did, all his righteous deeds which he did shall certainly not be remembered; in his transgression which he committed and in his sins which he sinned, in them he will die. —

25 And you said, The Lord's way is not straight. Hear indeed, all the house of Israel; is my way not straight? Is it not your way that is not straight?

26 When the righteous one turns from his righteousness and commits a transgression and dies, in the transgression which he did, in it he will die.

27 And when a lawless one turns from his lawlessness which he did and executes judgment and righteousness, this one preserved his soul

28 and turned from all his impieties which he did; he will live with life, shall certainly not die.

29 And the house of Israel says, The Lord's way does not go rightly. Does my way not go rightly, house of Israel? Is it not your way that does not go rightly?

30 Each according to his way I will judge you, house of Israel, says the Lord; return and turn away from all your impieties, and they will not be a punishment of injustice for you.

31 Cast away from yourselves all your impieties which you committed against me and make yourselves a new heart and a new spirit; and why do you die, house of Israel?

32 Because I do not desire the death of him who dies, says the Lord.

Chapter 19

1 And you, take up a lament over the ruler of Israel

2 and say, What is your mother? A cub; she became amid lions, amid lions she multiplied her cubs.

3 And one of her cubs leaped away, became a lion and learned to seize plunder, ate people.

4 And nations heard against him, he was captured in their destruction, and they brought him in a muzzle to the land of Egypt.

5 And she saw that he was rejected from her and her confidence perished, and she took another of her cubs, appointed him a lion.

6 And he moved about amid lions, became a lion and learned to seize plunder, ate people;

7 and he ranged in his boldness and made their cities desolate and destroyed a land and its fullness from the sound of his roaring.

8 And nations from countries round about set against him and spread their nets over him; he was captured in their destruction;

9 and they placed him in a muzzle and in a cage, he came to the king of Babylon, and he brought him into prison, so that his voice should not be heard upon the mountains of Israel. —

10 Your mother is like a vine, like a flower in a pomegranate tree planted in water; her fruit and her shoot came from much water.

11 And she had a rod of strength over a tribe of leaders, and she was raised in her size amid trunks and saw her size in the multitude of her branches.

12 And she was broken in wrath, thrown upon earth, and the scorching wind dried her choice parts; her rod of strength was punished and dried up, fire consumed it.

13 And now they have planted her in the wilderness, in a waterless land;

14 and fire went out from a rod of her choice parts and devoured her, and there was no rod of strength in her. A tribe is for a parable of lament and will be for lament.

Chapter 20

1 And it happened in the seventh year, in the fifth month, on the tenth of the month, men from the elders of the house of Israel came to inquire of the Lord and sat before my face.

2 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

3 Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel and say to them, Thus says the Lord, Do you come to inquire of me? I live, I will not answer you, says the Lord.

4 Shall I punish them with punishment? Son of man, testify to them concerning their fathers' lawless deeds

5 and say to them, Thus says the Lord, From the day when I chose the house of Israel and made myself known to the seed of the house of Iakob and became known to them in the land of Egypt and took hold of them with my hand, saying, I am the Lord your God,

6 on that day I took hold of them with my hand to bring them out of the land of Egypt into the land which I prepared for them, a land flowing with milk and honey; it is a honeycomb beyond all the earth.

7 And I said to them, Let each cast away the abominations of his eyes, and do not be defiled in the practices of Egypt; I am the Lord your God.

8 And they revolted from me and did not wish to hear me, did not cast away the abominations of their eyes and did not abandon the practices of Egypt. And I said that I would pour out my wrath upon them, to complete my anger among them amid the land of Egypt.

9 And I acted so that my name should not be profaned at all before the nations among whom they are, among whom I became known to them before them by bringing them out of the land of Egypt.

10 And I brought them out of the land of Egypt and brought them into the wilderness

11 and gave them my ordinances and made my just requirements known to them, which a person shall do and live in them.

12 And I gave them my sabbaths to be a sign between me and them, that they know that I am the Lord who sanctifies them.

13 And I said to the house of Israel in the wilderness, Walk in my ordinances. And they did not walk and rejected my just requirements which a person shall do and live in them, and greatly profaned my sabbaths. And I said that I would pour out my wrath upon them in the wilderness to consume them.

14 And I acted so that my name should not be profaned at all before the nations before whose eyes I brought them out.

15 And I raised my hand against them in the wilderness, not at all to bring them into the land which I gave them, a land flowing with milk and honey; it is a honeycomb beyond all the earth,

16 because they rejected my just requirements and did not walk in my ordinances, in them, and profaned my sabbaths and went after the thoughts of their hearts.

17 And my eye spared them from obliterating them, and I did not bring them to an end in the wilderness.

18 And I said to their children in the wilderness, Do not walk in the statutes of your fathers and do not keep their just requirements and do not mingle in their practices and do not be defiled;

19 I am the Lord your God; walk in my ordinances and keep my just requirements and do them,

20 and sanctify my sabbaths, and let them be a sign between me and you, to know that I am the Lord your God.

21 And their children also provoked me to bitterness; they did not walk in my ordinances and did not keep my just requirements to do them, which a person shall do and live in them, and profaned my sabbaths. And I said that I would pour out my wrath upon them in the wilderness, to complete my anger against them;

22 and I acted so that my name should not be profaned at all before the nations before whose eyes I brought them out.

23 And I raised my hand against them in the wilderness, to scatter them among the nations and disperse them in the countries,

24 because they did not do my just requirements and rejected my ordinances and profaned my sabbaths, and their eyes were after their fathers' thoughts.

25 And I gave them ordinances not good and just requirements in which they will not live in them.

26 And I will defile them in their gifts when I pass through every thing opening a womb, so that I destroy them.

27 Therefore speak to the house of Israel, son of man, and say to them, Thus says the Lord, Until this your fathers provoked me to anger in their transgressions in which they transgressed against me.

28 And I brought them into the land for which I raised my hand to give it to them, and they saw every high hill and every shady tree and sacrificed there to their gods and appointed there a fragrant smell and poured out their libations there.

29 And I said to them, What is Abama, that you enter there? And they called its name Abama until this day.

30 Therefore say to the house of Israel, Thus says the Lord, Are you defiled in your fathers' lawless deeds and do you prostitute yourselves after their abominations?

31 And in the firstfruits of your gifts, in the things set apart, you are defiled in all your thoughts until this day. And shall I answer you, house of Israel? I live, says the Lord, I will not answer you, nor shall this rise upon your spirit.

32 And it will not be as you say, We shall be like the nations and like the tribes of the earth, to serve wood and stones.

33 Therefore I live, says the Lord, with a mighty hand and a high arm and wrath poured out I will reign over you;

34 and I will bring you out from the peoples and receive you from the countries where you were scattered in them, with a mighty hand and a high arm and wrath poured out;

35 and I will bring you into the wilderness of the peoples and contend with you there face to face.

36 As I contended with your fathers in the wilderness of the land of Egypt, so I will judge you, says the Lord;

37 and I will lead you under my rod and bring you in by number

38 and select from among you the impious and the rebels, because I will bring them out from their sojourning, and they will not enter the land of Israel; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

39 And you, house of Israel, thus says the Lord Lord, Remove, each, his practices; and after these things, surely you will hear me and no longer profane my holy name with your gifts and your practices;

40 because upon my holy mountain, upon a high mountain, says the Lord Lord, there all the house of Israel will serve me completely, and there I will receive and there I will inspect your firstfruits and the firstfruits of your things set apart in all your holy things;

41 in a fragrant smell I will receive you when I bring you out from the peoples and receive you from the countries in which you were scattered in them, and I will be sanctified among you before the eyes of the peoples.

42 And you will recognize that I am the Lord when I bring you into the land of Israel, into the land for which I raised my hand to give it to your fathers.

43 And there you will remember your ways and your practices in which you were defiled in them, and beat your faces for all your wickedness.

44 And you will recognize that I am the Lord when I deal thus with you so that my name may not be profaned according to your evil ways and according to your corrupted practices, says the Lord.

Chapter 21

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, set your face against Thaiman and look upon Darom and prophesy against the leading forest Nageb

3 and say to the forest Nageb, Hear the word of the Lord: Thus says the Lord Lord, Behold, I kindle fire in you, and it will devour in you every green tree and every dry tree; the kindled flame will not be quenched, and in it every face will be burned from east to north;

4 and all flesh will recognize that I the Lord burned it, and it will not be quenched.

5 And I said, By no means, Lord Lord; they say to me, Is not this spoken as a parable?

6 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

7 Therefore prophesy, son of man, and set your face against Ierusalem and look upon their holy things and prophesy against the land of Israel

8 and say to the land of Israel, Behold, I am against you and will draw my dagger from its sheath and destroy unjust and lawless from you;

9 because I will destroy unjust and lawless from you, so my dagger will go out from its sheath against all flesh from east to north;

10 and all flesh will recognize that I the Lord drew my dagger from its sheath, and it will no longer return.

11 And you, son of man, groan with the crushing of your waist and groan in pains before their eyes.

12 And it will be, if they say to you, For what do you groan? And you shall say, Over the report, because it comes, and every heart will be shattered, and all hands will be paralyzed, and all flesh and every spirit will faint, and all thighs will be defiled with moisture; behold, it comes and will be, says the Lord Lord. —

13 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

14 Son of man, prophesy and say, Thus says the Lord, Say, Sword, sword, be sharpened and be enraged,

15 so that you slaughter victims; be sharpened so that you become glittering; ready for paralysis, slaughter, despise, thrust away every tree.

16 And he made it ready for his hand to hold; a sword was whetted, it is ready to be given into the hand of one piercing through.

17 Cry out and howl, son of man, because it came among my people, it among all the leaders of Israel; they will sojourn upon sword, it came among my people; therefore clap upon your hand.

18 Because it has been justified; and what if even a tribe was rejected? It will not be, says the Lord Lord.

19 And you, son of man, prophesy and clap hand upon hand and double a sword; the third sword of wounded ones is the great sword of wounded ones and will dismay them,

20 so that the heart may be shattered and the weak multiplied at every gate of theirs; they have been handed over as victims of sword; it has been made well for slaughter, made well for glittering.

21 Pass through, be sharpened on the right and on the left, wherever your face is stirred up.

22 And I too will clap my hand against my hand and let my wrath loose; I the Lord have spoken. —

23 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

24 And you, son of man, arrange for yourself two ways for the sword of the king of Babylon to enter; from one country the two will go out, and a hand at the beginning of a city's road; at the beginning

25 of a road you shall arrange for a sword to enter against Rabbath of the sons of Ammon and against Ioudaia and against Ierusalem in her midst.

26 Because the king of Babylon will stand upon the ancient road at the beginning of the two roads to divine a divination, to shake a rod and inquire among the carved images and inspect a liver on his right.

27 The oracle came against Ierusalem, to cast a rampart, to open a mouth in shouting, to raise a voice with a cry, to cast a rampart against her gates and cast a mound and build missile stations.

28 And he is to them as one divining a divination before them, and he reminding of his injustices, to be remembered.

29 Therefore thus says the Lord, Because you brought your injustices to remembrance when your impieties were uncovered, so that your sins might be seen in all your impieties and in your practices, because you brought them to remembrance, in these you will be caught.

30 And you, profane lawless leader of Israel, whose day has come, an end in a time of injustice,

31 thus says the Lord, You removed the turban and put on the crown; this will not be such; you humbled the high and raised the low.

32 Injustice, injustice I will make it, nor will this be such, until he comes to whom it belongs, and I will hand it to him. —

33 And you, son of man, prophesy and say, Thus says the Lord to the sons of Ammon and to their reproach, and you shall say, Sword, sword, drawn for victims and drawn for an end, arise so that you glitter

34 in your vain vision and in your divining false things, to hand you over upon the necks of lawless wounded ones whose day has come, an end in a time of injustice.

35 Turn back, do not lodge in this place where you were born; in your own land I will judge you

36 and pour out my anger upon you, with the fire of my anger blow upon you and hand you into the hands of barbarous men fashioning destruction.

37 In fire you will be food; your blood will be amid your land; there shall certainly be no remembrance of you, because I the Lord have spoken.

Chapter 22

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 And you, son of man, will you judge the city of bloodshed? And show her all her lawless deeds

3 and say, Thus says the Lord Lord, O city pouring out blood in her midst that her time may come, and making thoughts against herself to defile her,

4 in their blood which you poured out you have transgressed, and in your thoughts which you made you were defiled, and you brought your days near and brought the time of your years. Therefore I have made you a reproach to the nations and a mockery to all the countries

5 which draw near to you and which are far away from you, and they will mock you: The renowned one is unclean and abundant in lawless deeds.

6 Behold, the leaders of the house of Israel, each toward his relatives, mingled together in you so that they pour out blood;

7 they spoke evil of father and mother in you and dealt with the sojourner in injustices in you, oppressed orphan and widow in you;

8 and they despised my holy things and profaned my sabbaths in you.

9 Robber men are in you to pour out blood in you, and they ate upon the mountains in you, did unholy things in your midst.

10 They uncovered a father's shame in you and humbled a woman sitting apart in uncleannesses in you;

11 each acted lawlessly with his neighbor's wife, and each defiled his daughter-in-law in impiety, and each humbled his sister, his father's daughter, in you.

12 They took gifts in you to pour out blood, took interest and excess in you; and you completed the completion of your wickedness in oppression, but forgot me, says the Lord.

13 But if I strike my hand against my hand over the things you have completed, which you did, and over your bloodshed which occurred in your midst,

14 will your heart endure? Will your hands prevail in the days when I act in you? I the Lord have spoken and will do.

15 And I will scatter you among the nations and disperse you in the countries, and your uncleanness will cease from you,

16 and I will take possession in you before the eyes of the nations; and you will know that I am the Lord. —

17 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

18 Son of man, behold, the house of Israel has become to me all mixed with bronze and iron and tin and lead, mixed amid silver.

19 Therefore say, Thus says the Lord, Because you all became one mixture, therefore I receive you into the midst of Ierusalem.

20 As silver and bronze and iron and tin and lead are received into the midst of a furnace, to blow fire into it to be melted, so I will receive you in my anger and gather and melt you

21 and blow upon you with the fire of my anger, and you will be melted in her midst.

22 As silver is melted amid a furnace, so you will be melted in her midst; and you will recognize that I the Lord poured out my wrath upon you. —

23 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

24 Son of man, say to her, You are a land not wetted, nor did rain come upon you on a day of anger;

25 whose leaders in her midst are like roaring lions seizing plunder, devouring souls with power, taking valuables in injustice, and your widows were multiplied in your midst.

26 And her priests rejected my law and profaned my holy things; they did not distinguish between holy and profane and did not distinguish between unclean and clean and covered their eyes from my sabbaths, and I was profaned in their midst.

27 Her rulers in her midst are like wolves seizing plunder, to pour out blood, so that they gain with greed.

28 And her prophets plastering them will fall, seeing vain things, divining false things, saying, Thus says the Lord, and the Lord has not spoken;

29 oppressing the people of the land with injustice and plundering plunder, oppressing poor and needy and not dealing with the sojourner with judgment.

30 And I sought among them a man walking rightly and standing before my face wholly in the land's time, so as not to obliterate her utterly, and found none.

31 And I poured out my wrath upon her with the fire of my anger to bring to an end; I have brought their ways upon their heads, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 23

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, two women were daughters of one mother

3 and prostituted themselves in Egypt in their youth; there their breasts fell, there they were deflowered.

4 And their names were Oola the elder and Ooliba her sister. And they became mine and bore sons and daughters. And their names: Samareia is Oola, and Ierusalem is Ooliba.

5 And Oola prostituted herself away from me and set her desire upon her lovers, upon the Assyrians who drew near her,

6 clothed in blue, leaders and generals; all choice young men, horsemen riding upon horses.

7 And she gave her prostitution to them; all choice sons of Assyrians, and toward all whom she desired, she was defiled in all her thoughts.

8 And she did not abandon her prostitution from Egypt, because they lay with her in her youth, and they deflowered her and poured out their prostitution upon her.

9 Therefore I handed her into the hands of her lovers, into the hands of sons of Assyrians whom she desired.

10 They uncovered her shame, took her sons and daughters and killed her by sword; and she became a talk among women, and they executed acts of vengeance upon her for the daughters. —

11 And her sister Ooliba saw and corrupted her desire beyond her and her prostitution beyond her sister's prostitution.

12 She desired the sons of the Assyrians, leaders and generals near her, clothed in well-bordered garments, horsemen riding upon horses; all choice young men.

13 And I saw that she has been defiled; one way for the two.

14 And she added to her prostitution and saw men painted upon the wall, images of Chaldeans painted with a stylus,

15 girded with embroidered things upon their waists, and dyed tiaras upon their heads, a threefold appearance of all, a likeness of sons of Chaldeans of their native land,

16 and she desired them at the sight of her eyes and sent out messengers to them to the land of the Chaldeans.

17 And sons of Babylon came to her into a bed of those lodging and defiled her in her prostitution, and she was defiled with them; and her soul departed from them.

18 And she uncovered her prostitution and uncovered her shame, and my soul departed from her, as my soul departed from her sister.

19 And you multiplied your prostitution to recall the days of your youth in which you prostituted yourself in Egypt,

20 and you desired the Chaldeans, whose flesh was like that of donkeys, and their genitals the genitals of horses.

21 And you revisited the lawlessness of your youth, what you did in Egypt in your lodging, where were the breasts of your youth. —

22 Therefore, Ooliba, thus says the Lord, Behold, I stir up your lovers against you, from whom your soul departed, and I will bring them against you round about,

23 sons of Babylon and all the Chaldeans, Phakoud and Soue and Koue and all sons of Assyrians with them, choice young men, all governors and generals, men of the third rank and renowned ones riding upon horses;

24 and all will come against you from the north, chariots and wheels with a crowd of peoples, large shields and small shields, and they will set a guard against you round about; and I will set judgment before their face, and they will punish you with their judgments.

25 And I will put my jealousy in you, and they will deal with you in the anger of wrath; they will remove your nose and your ears and cast down your remnants by sword. They will take your sons and your daughters, and fire will devour your remnants.

26 And they will strip you of your apparel and take the vessels of your boasting.

27 And I will turn your impieties away from you and your prostitution from the land of Egypt, and you shall certainly not lift your eyes toward them and certainly no longer remember Egypt.

28 Because thus says the Lord Lord, Behold, I hand you into the hands of those whom you hate, from whom your soul departed;

29 and they will deal with you in hatred and take all your labors and your toils, and you will be naked and indecent, and the shame of your prostitution and your impiety will be uncovered. And your prostitution

30 did these things to you when you prostituted yourself after nations and were defiled in their thoughts.

31 You walked in your sister's way, and I will give her cup into your hands.

32 Thus says the Lord, You shall drink your sister's cup, the deep and wide one, abundant to bring to an end;

33 you will be filled with drunkenness and faintness; and the cup of destruction, the cup of your sister Samareia,

34 and you shall drink it; and I will turn away her feasts and her new moons; because I have spoken, says the Lord.

35 Therefore thus says the Lord, Because you forgot me and cast me behind your body, you too bear your impiety and your prostitution. —

36 And the Lord said to me, Son of man, will you not judge Oola and Ooliba? And you shall announce their lawless deeds to them,

37 because they committed adultery, and blood is in their hands; they committed adultery with their thoughts and led their children whom they bore to me through fire offerings for them.

38 They even did these things to me: they defiled my holy things and profaned my sabbaths.

39 And when they slaughtered their children to their idols, they also entered my holy things to profane them; and because they did thus amid my house.

40 And because for the men coming from afar, to whom they sent out messengers, and as soon as they came, immediately you washed and painted your eyes with antimony and adorned yourself with adornment

41 and sat upon a spread couch, and an adorned table before her face. And my incense and my oil, they delighted in them.

42 And they struck up a sound of harmony; and toward men from a multitude of people coming from the wilderness, and they gave bracelets upon their hands and a crown of boasting upon their heads.

43 And I said, Do they not commit adultery with these? And deeds of a prostitute, and she herself prostituted herself.

44 And they entered to her as they enter to a prostitute woman, so they entered to Oola and to Ooliba to commit lawlessness.

45 And righteous men, they will punish them with the punishment of an adulteress and the punishment of blood, because they are adulteresses, and blood is in their hands.

46 Thus says the Lord Lord, Bring a crowd against them and set turmoil and plundering among them

47 and stone them with stones of crowds and pierce them through with their swords; they will kill their sons and their daughters and burn their houses.

48 And I will turn impiety away from the land, and all women will be disciplined and certainly not act according to their impieties.

49 And your impiety will be brought upon you, and you will bear the sins of your thoughts; and you will know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 24

1 And the word of the Lord came to me in the ninth year, in the tenth month, on the tenth of the month, saying,

2 Son of man, write for yourself for a day, from this day on which the king of Babylon pressed against Ierusalem, from this very day,

3 and speak a parable against the house provoking to bitterness and say to them, Thus says the Lord, Set the pot and pour water into it

4 and put into it the cut pieces, every good cut piece, leg and shoulder with flesh removed from the bones,

5 taken from choice animals, and burn the bones underneath them; it boiled, it boiled, and her bones have been boiled in her midst.

6 Therefore thus says the Lord, O city of bloodshed, a pot in which there is corrosion, and the corrosion did not go out from her; limb by limb he brought out from her, no lot fell upon her.

7 Because her blood is in her midst, I have set it upon a smooth rock; I have not poured it upon the earth to cover earth over it.

8 That wrath may rise for vengeance to be executed, I have put her blood upon a smooth rock so as not to cover it.

9 Therefore thus says the Lord, I too will make the firebrand great

10 and multiply the wood and kindle the fire, so that the meat may melt and the broth be diminished,

11 and it stand upon the coals, so that her bronze may be burned and heated and melt amid her uncleanness, and her corrosion cease,

12 and her abundant corrosion shall certainly not go out from her; her corrosion will be put to shame,

13 because you were defiled. And what if you are not yet cleansed until I fill my wrath?

14 I the Lord have spoken, and it will come, and I will do; I will not hold back nor have mercy; according to your ways and according to your thoughts I will judge you, says the Lord. Therefore I will judge you according to your bloodshed and according to your thoughts judge you, the unclean renowned one, abundant in provoking to bitterness.

15 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

16 Son of man, behold, I take from you the desirable things of your eyes in battle array; you shall certainly not mourn nor weep.

17 There is a groan of blood, of waist, of mourning; your hair shall not be intertwined upon you, and your footwear on your feet; you shall certainly not be comforted by their lips nor eat the bread of men.

18 And I spoke to the people in the morning as he commanded me, and my wife died in the evening, and in the morning I did as I was commanded.

19 And the people said to me, Will you not announce to us what these things are which you do?

20 And I said to them, The word of the Lord came to me, saying,

21 Say to the house of Israel, Thus says the Lord, Behold, I profane my holy things, the arrogance of your strength, the desirable things of your eyes, and the things for which your souls spare; and your sons and your daughters whom you abandoned will fall by sword.

22 And you shall do as I have done; you will not be comforted from their mouth and will not eat the bread of men,

23 and your hair upon your head, and your footwear on your feet; you shall neither mourn nor weep and will waste away in your injustices and comfort, each, his brother.

24 And Iezekiel will be a portent for you; according to all that he did you shall do when these things come; and you will recognize that I am the Lord. —

25 And you, son of man, will not, on the day when I take from them their strength, the elevation of their boasting, the desirable things of their eyes and the elevation of their soul, their sons and their daughters,

26 on that day the survivor come to you to announce into your ears?

27 On that day your mouth will be opened toward the survivor, and you will speak and certainly no longer be made mute; and you will be a portent for them, and they will recognize that I am the Lord.

Chapter 25

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, set your face against the sons of Ammon and prophesy against them

3 and say to the sons of Ammon, Hear the word of the Lord: Thus says the Lord, Because you rejoiced over my holy things because they were profaned, and over the land of Israel because it was destroyed, and over the house of Iouda because they went into captivity,

4 therefore behold, I hand you over to the sons of Kedem for an inheritance, and they will encamp with their equipment in you and place their dwellings in you; they will eat your fruits, and they will drink your richness.

5 And I will make the city of Ammon pastures of camels and the sons of Ammon a pasture of sheep; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

6 Because thus says the Lord, Because you clapped your hand and stamped with your foot and rejoiced from your soul over the land of Israel,

7 therefore I will stretch my hand against you and make you plunder among the nations and destroy you from the peoples and bring you to destruction from the countries; and you will recognize that I am the Lord.

8 Thus says the Lord, Because Moab said, Behold, the house of Israel and Iouda is like all the nations,

9 therefore behold, I paralyze Moab's shoulder from the cities of his extremities, a choice land, the house of Asimouth above a spring of a seaside city.

10 To the sons of Kedem against the sons of Ammon I have given them for an inheritance, so that no remembrance of the sons of Ammon may be;

11 and upon Moab I will execute vengeance, and they will recognize that I am the Lord.

12 Thus says the Lord, Because Idoumaia acted by executing vengeance upon the house of Iouda and bore a grudge and exacted punishment,

13 therefore thus says the Lord, And I will stretch my hand against Idoumaia and destroy human and beast from her and make her desolate, and those pursued from Thaiman will fall by sword;

14 and I will put my vengeance upon Idoumaia by the hand of my people Israel, and they will act in Idoumaia according to my anger and according to my wrath; and they will recognize my vengeance, says the Lord.

15 Therefore thus says the Lord, Because the foreigners acted in vengeance and raised up vengeance, rejoicing from the soul to obliterate forever,

16 therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, I will stretch my hand against the foreigners and destroy Cretans and destroy the remnants inhabiting the coast;

17 and I will execute great acts of vengeance among them, and they will recognize that I am the Lord when I put my vengeance upon them.

Chapter 26

1 And it happened in the eleventh year, on the first of the month, the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, because Sor said over Ierusalem, Well done, she was crushed, the nations have perished, she turned to me, the full one has been made desolate,

3 therefore thus says the Lord, Behold, I am against you, Sor, and I will bring many nations against you, as the sea rises with its waves.

4 And they will cast down the walls of Sor and cast down your towers, and I will winnow her dust away from her and make her a smooth rock;

5 she will be a drying place for nets amid the sea, because I have spoken, says the Lord; and she will be plunder for the nations,

6 and her daughters in the plain will be killed by sword; and they will know that I am the Lord.

7 Because thus says the Lord, Behold, I bring against you, Sor, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon from the north [he is king of kings], with horses and chariots and horsemen and a gathering of exceedingly many nations.

8 This one will kill your daughters in the plain by sword and set an advance guard against you and build round about and make a rampart against you round about and an encirclement of weapons and place his spears opposite you;

9 your walls and your towers he will cast down with his swords.

10 From the multitude of his horses their dust will cover you, and from the sound of his horsemen and the wheels of his chariots your walls will be shaken as he enters your gates, as one entering a city from a plain.

11 With the hoofs of his horses they will trample all your squares; he will kill your people by sword and bring the foundation of your strength down to the earth.

12 And he will plunder your wealth and spoil your possessions and cast down your walls and pull down your desirable houses and throw your stones and your wood and your dust into the midst of the sea.

13 And he will stop the multitude of your musicians, and the sound of your harps shall certainly no longer be heard.

14 And I will make you a smooth rock, you will be a drying place for nets; you shall certainly no longer be built, because I spoke, says the Lord.

15 Because thus says the Lord Lord to Sor, Will not the islands be shaken from the sound of your fall, when wounded ones groan, when a sword is drawn in your midst?

16 And all the rulers from the nations of the sea will descend from their thrones and remove the headdresses from their heads and strip off their embroidered apparel; with dismay they will be dismayed, sit upon the earth and fear their destruction and groan over you;

17 and they will take up a lament over you and say to you, How were you brought down from the sea, the praised city which gave her fear to all who inhabit her?

18 And the islands will fear from the day of your fall.

19 Because thus says the Lord Lord, When I make you a desolate city like the cities which will not be inhabited, when I bring the abyss upon you and much water covers you,

20 and I will bring you down to those descending into a pit, to a people of old, and settle you in the depths of the earth as an everlasting wilderness with those descending into a pit, so that you may not be inhabited nor rise upon a land of life.

21 I will make you destruction, and you will no longer exist forever, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 27

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, take up a lament over Sor

3 and say to Sor, who dwells at the entrance of the sea, the trading place of the peoples from many islands, Thus says the Lord to Sor, You said, I put my beauty around myself.

4 In the heart of the sea, for Beelim, your sons put beauty around you.

5 Cedar from Sanir was built for you; strips of cypress planks from Lebanon were taken to make fir masts for you.

6 From Basanitis they made your oars; your holy things they made from ivory, wooded houses from the islands of the Chettiin.

7 Fine linen with embroidery from Egypt became your covering, to put glory around you and wrap you in blue and purple from the islands of Elisai, and became your coverings.

8 And your rulers who inhabit Sidon and Aradians became your rowers; your wise ones, Sor, who were in you, these were your pilots.

9 The elders of the Byblians and their wise ones were in you, these strengthened your counsel; and all the ships of the sea and their rowers became yours toward the farthest west.

10 Persians and Lydians and Libyans were in your army, your warrior men hung shields and helmets in you, these gave your glory.

11 Sons of Aradians and your army were guards upon your walls, in your towers; they hung their quivers upon your moorings round about; these perfected your beauty.

12 Carthaginians were your merchants from the abundance of all your strength; silver and gold and iron and tin and lead they gave for your market.

13 Hellas and the whole and the neighboring lands, these traded with you in human souls and gave bronze vessels for your commerce.

14 From the house of Thergama they gave horses and horsemen for your market.

15 Sons of Rhodians were your merchants from islands; they multiplied your commerce with ivory tusks, and for the imported things you gave your payments in return,

16 people as your merchandise from the abundance of your mixed wares, myrrh and embroidered things from Tharsis, and Ramoth and Chorchor they gave for your market.

17 Ioudas and the sons of Israel, these were your merchants in the sale of grain and perfumes and cassia, and first honey and oil and resin they gave into your mixed wares.

18 Damascus was your merchant from the abundance of all your wealth; wine from Chelbon and wool from Miletos;

19 and wine they gave for your market. From Asel worked iron and a wheel are among your mixed wares.

20 Daidan were your merchants with choice beasts for chariots.

21 Arabia and all the rulers of Kedar, these were your merchants through your hand, camels and rams and lambs with which they trade with you.

22 Merchants of Saba and Ragma, these were your merchants with foremost spices and good stones, and gold they gave for your market.

23 Charran and Channa, these were your merchants. Assour and Charman were your merchants,

24 bringing merchandise, blue and choice treasures bound with cords and cypress things.

25 Ships, in them Carthaginians were your merchants in the multitude among your mixed wares, and you were filled and made exceedingly heavy in the heart of the sea.

26 In much water your rowers led you; the south wind crushed you in the heart of the sea.

27 There were your riches and your payment and that of your mixed wares and your rowers and your pilots and your counselors and your traders from your mixed wares and all your warrior men in you and all your gathering in your midst; they will fall in the heart of the sea on the day of your fall.

28 At the sound of your cry your pilots will fear with fear,

29 and all your rowers will descend from the ships, and the passengers and the bowmen of the sea will stand upon the earth

30 and shout over you with their voice and cry bitterly and place earth upon their head and spread ash beneath themselves.

32 And their sons will take up a lament over you and a lamentation for you,

33 How great a payment did you find from the sea? You filled nations from your multitude and from your mixed wares enriched all kings of the earth.

34 Now you were crushed in the sea, in the depth of water; your mixed wares and all your gathering in your midst fell, all your rowers.

35 All who inhabit the islands grew gloomy over you, and their kings were dismayed with dismay, and their face shed tears.

36 Merchants from nations hissed at you; you became destruction and shall no longer be forever.

Chapter 28

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 And you, son of man, say to the ruler of Tyre, Thus says the Lord, Because your heart was raised, and you said, I am God, I have inhabited a dwelling of God in the heart of the sea, but you are a human and not God, and you made your heart like God's heart,

3 are you wiser than Daniel? Did wise ones not instruct you in their knowledge?

4 Did you not by your knowledge or your understanding make wealth for yourself and gold and silver in your treasuries?

5 By your abundant knowledge and your commerce you multiplied your wealth; your heart was raised in your wealth.

6 Therefore thus says the Lord, Since you made your heart like God's heart,

7 in return for this behold, I bring against you foreign pests from nations, and they will draw their swords against you and against the beauty of your knowledge and lay your beauty low unto destruction

8 and bring you down, and you will die the death of wounded ones in the heart of the sea.

9 Will you, speaking, say, I am God, before those killing you? But you are a human and not God. In a multitude

10 of uncircumcised ones you will perish in the hands of foreigners; because I spoke, says the Lord.

11 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

12 Son of man, take up a lament over the ruler of Tyre and say to him, Thus says the Lord Lord, You are a seal of likeness and a crown of beauty;

13 you were in the delight of God's paradise; you have bound upon yourself every good stone, sardion and topaz and emerald and carbuncle and sapphire and jasper and silver and gold and ligyrion and agate and amethyst and chrysolite and beryl and onyx, and you filled your treasuries and your storehouses in you with gold from the day when you were created.

14 With the cheroub I placed you upon God's holy mountain; you were amid fiery stones.

15 You were blameless in your days from the day when you were created until the wrongs were found in you.

16 From the abundance of your commerce you filled your chambers with lawlessness and sinned and were wounded away from God's mountain, and the cheroub led you from amid fiery stones.

17 Your heart was raised on account of your beauty, your knowledge was corrupted with your beauty; because of the multitude of your sins I threw you upon the earth, gave you before kings to be made an example.

18 Because of the multitude of your sins and the injustices of your commerce you profaned your holy places; and I will bring fire out from your midst, this will devour you; and I will make you ash upon your earth before all who see you.

19 And all who know you among the nations will grow gloomy over you; you became destruction and shall no longer exist forever.

20 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

21 Son of man, set your face against Sidon and prophesy against her

22 and say, Thus says the Lord, Behold, I am against you, Sidon, and I will be glorified in you, and you will know that I am the Lord when I execute judgments in you, and I will be sanctified in you.

23 Blood and death in your squares, and wounded ones will fall by swords in you round about you; and they will know that I am the Lord.

24 And they will no longer be to the house of Israel a prickle of bitterness and a thorn of pain, from all those round about them who dishonored them; and they will know that I am the Lord.

25 Thus says the Lord Lord, And I will gather Israel from the nations where they were scattered there, and I will be sanctified in them before the peoples and the nations; and they will dwell upon their land which I have given to my servant Iakob,

26 and they will dwell upon it in hope and build houses and plant vineyards and dwell in hope, when I execute judgment upon all who dishonored them among those round about them; and they will know that I am the Lord their God and the God of their fathers.

Chapter 29

1 In the tenth year, in the tenth month, on the first of the month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, set your face against Pharao king of Egypt, and prophesy against him and against all Egypt,

3 and say, Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am against Pharao, the great dragon sitting in the midst of his rivers, who says, The rivers are mine, and I made them.

4 And I will put traps in your jaws and attach the fish of your river to your wings, and bring you up from the midst of your river, and all the fish of your river,

5 and cast you down quickly, and all the fish of your river. You shall fall upon the face of the plain, and you shall certainly not be gathered, and you shall certainly not be wrapped up; I have given you to the beasts of the earth and to the birds of heaven for devouring.

6 And all those inhabiting Egypt shall know that I am the Lord, because you became a reed staff for the house of Israel.

7 When they took hold of you with their hand, you were crushed; and when every hand prevailed against them, and when they rested upon you, you were shattered and broke all their loins together.

8 Therefore thus says the Lord: Behold, I bring a sword upon you, and I will destroy men and livestock from you;

9 and the land of Egypt shall be destruction and desert, and they shall know that I am the Lord, because you say, The rivers are mine, and I made them.

10 Therefore behold, I am against you and against all your rivers, and I will give the land of Egypt over to desert and sword and destruction, from Magdolon and Syene and as far as the borders of the Ethiopians.

11 A man's foot shall certainly not pass through it, and a beast's foot shall certainly not pass through it, and it shall not be inhabited for forty years.

12 And I will give its land over to destruction in the midst of a desolated land, and its cities shall be in the midst of desolated cities for forty years; and I will scatter Egypt among the nations and winnow them into the countries.

13 Thus says the Lord: After forty years I will gather the Egyptians from the nations where they were scattered,

14 and I will turn back the captivity of the Egyptians and settle them in the land of Pathoures, in the land from which they were taken; and it shall be a lowly dominion

15 beside all the dominions; it shall certainly no longer be exalted over the nations, and I will make them few, so that they shall not be more numerous among the nations.

16 And they shall no longer be for the house of Israel a hope reminding them of lawlessness when they follow after them; and they shall know that I am the Lord.

17 And it happened in the twenty-seventh year, on the first of the first month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

18 Son of man, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon subjected his force to great servitude against Tyre; every head bald and every shoulder shedding hair, and no wage came to him and to his force against Tyre and for the servitude with which they served against it.

19 Thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I give the land of Egypt to Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, and he shall plunder its plunder and despoil its spoils, and it shall be a wage for his force;

20 in return for his service with which he served against Tyre, I have given him the land of Egypt. Thus says the Lord Lord:

21 On that day a horn shall spring up for the whole house of Israel, and to you I will give an opened mouth in their midst; and they shall know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 30

1 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, prophesy and say, Thus says the Lord: Oh, oh, the day!

3 For the day of the Lord is near; it shall be a day, an end of nations.

4 And a sword shall come upon the Egyptians, and there shall be disturbance in Ethiopia, and wounded ones shall fall in Egypt, and its foundations shall collapse together.

5 Persians and Cretans and Lydians and Libyans and all the mixed peoples, and some of the sons of my covenant, shall fall by the sword in it.

6 And the supports of Egypt shall fall, and the insolence of its strength shall come down from Magdolon to Syene; they shall fall by the sword in it, says the Lord.

7 And it shall be desolated in the midst of desolated countries, and their cities shall be in the midst of desolated cities;

8 and they shall know that I am the Lord, when I put fire upon Egypt and all those helping it are shattered.

9 On that day messengers shall go out, hastening to make Ethiopia disappear, and there shall be disturbance among them on the day of Egypt, for behold, it comes. –

10 Thus says the Lord Lord: And I will destroy a multitude of Egyptians by the hand of Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon,

11 him and his people; pestilent ones sent from nations to destroy the land, and they shall all draw their swords against Egypt, and the land shall be filled with wounded ones.

12 And I will make their rivers desolate, and destroy the land and its fullness in the hands of foreigners; I, the Lord, have spoken. –

13 For thus says the Lord Lord: And I will destroy magnates from Memphis and rulers from the land of Egypt, and they shall no longer exist.

14 And I will destroy the land of Pathoures and put fire upon Tanis and execute vengeance in Diospolis,

15 and pour out my wrath upon Sais, the strength of Egypt, and destroy the multitude of Memphis;

16 and I will put fire upon Egypt, and Syene shall be disturbed with disturbance, and in Diospolis there shall be a bursting forth, and waters shall be poured out.

17 Young men of Heliopolis and Boubastos shall fall by the sword, and the women shall go in captivity.

18 And in Taphnas the day shall grow dark when I shatter there the scepters of Egypt, and the insolence of its strength shall perish there, and a cloud shall cover it, and its daughters shall be led away captive.

19 And I will execute judgment in Egypt, and they shall know that I am the Lord.

20 And it happened in the eleventh year, in the first month, on the seventh of the month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

21 Son of man, I shattered the arms of Pharao king of Egypt, and behold, it was not bound up for healing to be given, for a poultice to be put upon it, for strength to be given to take hold of a sword.

22 Therefore thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I am against Pharao king of Egypt, and I will shatter his arms, the strong ones and the outstretched ones, and cast down his sword from his hand,

23 and scatter Egypt into the nations and winnow them into the countries;

24 and I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon and put my sword into his hand, and he shall bring it upon Egypt and plunder its plunder and despoil its spoils.

25 And I will strengthen the arms of the king of Babylon, but the arms of Pharao shall fall; and they shall know that I am the Lord, when I put my sword into the hands of the king of Babylon, and he shall extend it over the land of Egypt.

26 And I will scatter Egypt into the nations and winnow them into the countries; and they shall all know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 31

1 And it happened in the eleventh year, in the third month, on the first of the month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, say to Pharao king of Egypt and to his multitude, To whom have you likened yourself in your height?

3 Behold, Assour, a cypress in Lebanon, and beautiful in its shoots and high in stature; its top came into the midst of clouds;

4 water nourished it, the abyss raised it high; it led its rivers around its plants and sent out its collections of water to all the trees of the plain.

5 Because of this its stature was raised above all the trees of the plain, and its branches spread wide from much water.

6 In its shoots all the birds of heaven nested, and beneath its branches all the beasts of the plain gave birth; in its shade every multitude of nations dwelt.

7 And it became beautiful in its height through the multitude of its branches, because its roots came into much water.

8 Such cypresses did not exist in the paradise of God, and pines were not like its shoots, and firs did not become like its branches; no tree in the paradise of God was likened to it in its beauty,

9 through the multitude of its branches, and the trees of the paradise of God's delight envied it. –

10 Therefore thus says the Lord: Because you became great in stature and put your top into the midst of clouds, and I saw when it was raised high,

11 I also delivered it into the hands of a ruler of nations, and he brought about its destruction.

12 And foreign pestilent ones from nations utterly destroyed it and cast it down upon the mountains; in all the ravines its branches fell, and its trunks were shattered in every plain of the earth, and all the peoples of the nations came down from their shelter and razed it to the ground.

13 Upon its fall all the birds of heaven rested, and upon its trunks all the beasts of the field came,

14 so that all the trees in the water might not be raised high in their stature; and they did not put their top into the midst of clouds, and all those drinking water did not stand against them in their height; all were given over to death, to the depth of the earth, in the midst of sons of men, to those descending into a pit. –

15 Thus says the Lord Lord: On the day when it descended into Hades, the abyss mourned it, and I stopped its rivers and held back a multitude of water, and Lebanon grew dark over it; all the trees of the plain fainted over it.

16 At the sound of its fall the nations were shaken, when I brought it down into Hades with those descending into a pit, and all the trees of delight and the choice ones of Lebanon, all those drinking water, comforted it in the earth.

17 For they too descended with it into Hades among those wounded by a sword, and its seed, those dwelling under its shelter, perished in the midst of their life.

18 To whom were you likened? Descend, and be brought down with the trees of delight into the depth of the earth; in the midst of the uncircumcised you shall lie with those wounded by a sword. Thus Pharao and the multitude of his strength, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 32

1 And it happened in the eleventh year, in the twelfth month, on the first of the month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, take up a lament over Pharao king of Egypt, and you shall say to him, You were likened to a lion of nations, and you were like a dragon in the sea, and you were butting with your rivers and disturbing water with your feet and trampling your rivers.

3 Thus says the Lord: And I will cast over you nets of many peoples and bring you up with my hook,

4 and stretch you out upon the earth; plains shall be filled with you, and I will seat upon you all the birds of heaven, and fill with you all the beasts of all the earth;

5 and I will put your flesh upon the mountains and fill them with your blood,

6 and the earth shall be watered from your excrements, from your multitude upon the mountains; I will fill ravines with you.

7 And when you are extinguished I will cover heaven and darken its stars; I will cover the sun with a cloud, and the moon shall certainly not show its light;

8 all those showing light in heaven shall grow dark over you, and I will put darkness upon your land, says the Lord Lord.

9 And I will provoke the heart of many peoples to anger when I bring your captivity into the nations, into a land which you did not know.

10 And many nations shall be gloomy over you, and their kings shall be beside themselves with consternation when my sword flies before their faces, awaiting their fall from the day of your fall.

11 For thus says the Lord: A sword of the king of Babylon shall come to you

12 with swords of giants, and I will cast down your strength; all pestilent ones from nations, and they shall destroy the insolence of Egypt, and all its strength shall be shattered.

13 And I will destroy all its livestock from much water, and a man's foot shall certainly no longer disturb it, and a footprint of livestock shall certainly not trample it.

14 Thus then their waters shall be still, and their rivers shall flow like oil, says the Lord.

15 When I give Egypt over to destruction and the land is desolated with its fullness, when I scatter all those dwelling in it, then they shall know that I am the Lord.

16 It is a lament, and you shall lament it, and the daughters of the nations shall lament it; over Egypt and over all its strength they shall lament it, says the Lord Lord.

17 And it happened in the twelfth year, in the first month, on the fifteenth of the month, a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

18 Son of man, lament over the strength of Egypt, and the nations shall bring down its daughters dead into the depth of the earth, to those descending into a pit;

20 in the midst of those wounded by a sword they shall fall with him, and all his strength shall lie down.

21 And the giants shall say to you, Be in the depth of a pit; of whom are you better? Descend and lie down with the uncircumcised in the midst of those wounded by a sword.

22 There Assour and all his assembly, all wounded, were placed there, and their burial is in the depth of a pit, and his assembly came to be around his tomb, all the wounded who have fallen by a sword,

23 who put their fear upon the land of life.

24 There Ailam and all his force around his tomb, all the wounded who have fallen by a sword, and those descending uncircumcised into the depth of the earth, who have put their fear upon the land of life, and they received their torment with those descending into a pit,

25 in the midst of wounded ones.

26 There Mosoch and Thobel were placed, and all their strength around his tomb, all his wounded, all uncircumcised ones wounded by a sword, who have put their fear upon the land of life;

27 and they lay down with the giants who have fallen from of old, who descended into Hades with weapons of war and put their swords under their heads; and their lawlessnesses came upon their bones, because they terrified giants in the land of life.

28 And you shall lie down in the midst of the uncircumcised, with those wounded by a sword.

29 There the rulers of Assour were placed, who gave his strength over to a wound of a sword; these lay down with wounded ones, with those descending into a pit.

30 There the rulers of the north, all generals of Assour, those descending wounded, with their fear and their strength, lay down uncircumcised with those wounded by a sword, and bore their torment with those descending into a pit.

31 King Pharao shall see those, and be comforted over all their strength, says the Lord Lord.

32 For I have put his fear upon the land of life, and he shall lie down in the midst of the uncircumcised, with those wounded by a sword, Pharao and all his multitude, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 33

1 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, speak to the sons of your people, and you shall say to them, A land upon which I bring a sword, and the people of the land take one man from among them and appoint him for themselves as a watchman,

3 and he sees the sword coming upon the land and blows the trumpet and signals to the people,

4 and the one hearing hears the sound of the trumpet and does not take heed, and the sword comes and overtakes him, his blood shall be upon his head;

5 because, having heard the sound of the trumpet, he did not take heed, his blood shall be upon him; and this one, because he took heed, rescued his soul.

6 And the watchman, if he sees the sword coming and does not signal with the trumpet, and the people do not take heed, and the sword comes and takes a soul from among them, this soul was taken because of its own lawlessness, and I will require the blood from the watchman's hand.

7 And you, son of man, I have appointed you a watchman for the house of Israel, and you shall hear a word from my mouth.

8 When I say to the sinner, By death you shall be put to death, and you do not speak so that the ungodly may take heed to keep from his way, the lawless one himself shall die in his lawlessness, but I will require his blood from your hand.

9 But if you forewarn the ungodly of his way, to turn away from it, and he does not turn away from his way, this one shall die in his ungodliness, and you have rescued your own soul. –

10 And you, son of man, say to the house of Israel, Thus you spoke, saying, Our errors and our lawlessnesses are upon us, and in them we are wasting away; and how shall we live?

11 Say to them, I live, thus says the Lord: I do not desire the death of the ungodly as I desire that the ungodly turn away from his way and live. Turn away with a turning away from your way; and why do you die, house of Israel?

12 Say to the sons of your people, A righteous man's righteousness shall certainly not rescue him on the day when he goes astray, and an ungodly man's lawlessness shall certainly not harm him on the day when he turns away from his lawlessness; and a righteous man shall certainly not be able to be saved.

13 When I say to the righteous man, This one has trusted in his righteousness, and he commits lawlessness, all his righteous deeds shall certainly not be remembered; in his injustice which he committed, in it he shall die.

14 And when I say to the ungodly, By death you shall be put to death, and he turns away from his sin and does judgment and righteousness,

15 and returns a pledge and repays what was seized, walks in ordinances of life so as not to do wrong, he shall live with life and shall certainly not die;

16 all his sins which he committed shall certainly not be remembered; because he did judgment and righteousness, in them he shall live.

17 And the sons of your people shall say, The way of the Lord is not straight; and this way of theirs is not straight.

18 When a righteous man turns away from his righteousness and commits lawlessnesses, he shall also die in them;

19 and when the sinner turns away from his lawlessness and does judgment and righteousness, in them he himself shall live.

20 And this is what you said, The way of the Lord is not straight; I will judge you, each in his ways, house of Israel.

21 And it happened in the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, on the fifth of the month of our captivity, the one who had escaped came to me from Ierusalem, saying, The city has been captured.

22 And the hand of the Lord came upon me in the evening before he came, and opened my mouth until he came to me in the morning; and my mouth, having been opened, was no longer restrained.

23 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

24 Son of man, those inhabiting the desolated places upon the land of Israel say, Abraam was one and possessed the land, and we are more numerous; the land has been given to us for a possession.

25 Therefore say to them, Thus says the Lord Lord:

27 I live: surely those in the desolated places shall fall by a sword, and those upon the face of the plain shall be given to the beasts of the field for devouring, and those in the fortified places and those in the caves I will kill with death.

28 And I will make the land desolate, and the insolence of its strength shall perish, and the mountains of Israel shall be desolated because there is no one passing through.

29 And they shall know that I am the Lord; and I will make their land desolate, and it shall be desolated because of all their abominations which they committed.

30 And you, son of man, the sons of your people who speak about you beside the walls and in the gateways of the houses, and speak, a man to his brother, saying, Let us come together and hear the things proceeding from the Lord,

31 come to you as a people comes together, and sit before you and hear your words, and they shall certainly not do them, because falsehood is in their mouth, and their heart is after defilements.

32 And you become to them like the sound of a sweet-voiced, well-tuned psaltery, and they shall hear your words and shall certainly not do them.

33 And when it comes, they shall say, Behold, it comes; and they shall know that a prophet was in their midst.

Chapter 34

1 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel; prophesy and say to the shepherds, Thus says the Lord Lord: O shepherds of Israel, do shepherds feed themselves? Do the shepherds not feed the sheep?

3 Behold, you consume the milk and clothe yourselves with the wool and slaughter the fat one, and you do not feed my sheep;

4 you did not strengthen the weak one, and did not restore the sick one's body, and did not bind up the shattered one, and did not turn back the straying one, and did not seek the lost one, and you worked the strong one with toil.

5 And my sheep were scattered because there were no shepherds, and became food for all the beasts of the field;

6 and my sheep were scattered on every mountain and upon every high hill, and were scattered upon the face of all the earth, and there was no one seeking them out or turning them back.

7 Therefore, shepherds, hear a word of the Lord:

8 I live, says the Lord Lord: surely, because my sheep became plunder and my sheep became food for all the beasts of the plain because there were no shepherds, and the shepherds did not seek out my sheep, and the shepherds fed themselves but did not feed my sheep,

9 because of this, shepherds,

10 thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I am against the shepherds, and I will require my sheep from their hands and turn them away from shepherding my sheep, and the shepherds shall no longer feed them; and I will rescue my sheep from their mouth, and they shall no longer be food for them.

11 For thus says the Lord: Behold, I will seek out my sheep and attend to them.

12 Just as the shepherd seeks his flock on a day when there is gloom and cloud among separated sheep, so I will seek out my sheep and drive them away from every place where they were scattered on a day of cloud and gloom.

13 And I will bring them out of the nations and gather them from the countries and bring them into their land, and feed them upon the mountains of Israel and in the ravines and in every inhabited place of the land;

14 in good pasture I will feed them, and on the high mountain of Israel shall be their folds; there they shall lie down and there they shall rest in good delight, and in rich pasture they shall be fed upon the mountains of Israel.

15 I will feed my sheep and I will give them rest, and they shall know that I am the Lord. Thus says the Lord Lord:

16 I will seek the lost one and turn back the straying one and bind up the shattered one and strengthen the failing one and guard the strong one, and feed them with judgment.

17 And you, sheep, thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I will distinguish between sheep and sheep, rams and goats;

18 and is it not enough for you that you grazed the good pasture, and trampled the remainder of your pasture with your feet? And you drank the settled water and disturbed the rest with your feet;

19 and my sheep grazed what your feet had trampled and drank the water disturbed by your feet.

20 Therefore thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I will distinguish between a strong sheep and a weak sheep.

21 With your sides and shoulders you push, and with your horns you were butting, and you were squeezing out every failing one.

22 And I will save my sheep, and they shall certainly no longer be plunder, and I will judge between ram and ram.

23 And I will raise up over them one shepherd, and he shall shepherd them, my servant Dauid, and he shall be their shepherd;

24 and I, the Lord, shall be a God to them, and Dauid a ruler in their midst; I, the Lord, have spoken.

25 And I will make with Dauid a covenant of peace and make evil beasts disappear from the land, and they shall dwell in the desert and sleep in the woods.

26 And I will place them around my mountain; and I will give you rain, rain of blessing.

27 And the trees in the plain shall give their fruit, and the land shall give its strength, and they shall dwell upon their land in hope of peace, and they shall know that I am the Lord when I shatter their yoke; and I will rescue them from the hand of those who enslaved them.

28 And they shall no longer be plunder for the nations, and the beasts of the earth shall certainly no longer eat them; and they shall dwell in hope, and there shall be no one terrifying them.

29 And I will raise up for them a plant of peace, and they shall no longer be perishing by famine upon the land, and shall certainly no longer bear the reproach of nations.

30 And they shall know that I am the Lord their God, and they are my people, the house of Israel, says the Lord.

31 You are my sheep and sheep of my flock, and I am the Lord your God, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 35

1 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, turn your face toward mount Seir and prophesy against it,

3 and say, Thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I am against you, mount Seir, and I will extend my hand against you and make you desolate, and you shall be desolated,

4 and I will make a desolation for your cities, and you shall be desolate; and you shall know that I am the Lord.

5 Because you became an everlasting enemy and lay in ambush for the house of Israel with deceit, in the hand of enemies, with a sword in a time of injustice at the end,

6 therefore, I live, says the Lord Lord: surely you sinned unto blood, and blood shall pursue you.

7 And I will make mount Seir a desert and a desolated place, and destroy men and livestock from it,

8 and fill the hills and your ravines with your wounded, and in all your plains those wounded by a sword shall fall in you.

9 I will make you an everlasting desolation, and your cities shall certainly no longer be inhabited; and you shall know that I am the Lord.

10 Because you said, The two nations and the two countries shall be mine, and I will inherit them, and the Lord is there,

11 therefore, I live, says the Lord, and I will do to you according to your enmity, and I will be known to you when I judge you;

12 and you shall know that I am the Lord. I heard the sound of your blasphemies, because you said, The mountains of Israel are desolate, they have been given to us for devouring;

13 and you spoke boastfully against me with your mouth; I heard.

14 Thus says the Lord: In the rejoicing of all the earth I will make you desolate;

15 you shall be desolate, mount Seir, and all Idoumaia shall be utterly consumed; and you shall know that I am the Lord their God.

Chapter 36

1 And you, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel and say to the mountains of Israel, Hear a word of the Lord:

2 Thus says the Lord Lord: Because the enemy said against you, Well done! Everlasting deserts have become a possession for us,

3 therefore prophesy and say, Thus says the Lord Lord: Because you were dishonored and hated by those around you, so that you became a possession for the remaining nations, and you came up as talk upon a tongue and as a reproach to nations,

4 therefore, mountains of Israel, hear a word of the Lord: Thus says the Lord to the mountains and the hills and the ravines and the torrents and the utterly desolated and vanished places and the abandoned cities, which became plunder and something trampled for the nations remaining round about;

5 therefore thus says the Lord Lord: Surely in the fire of my wrath I spoke against the remaining nations and against all Idoumaia, because they gave my land to themselves for a possession with rejoicing, dishonoring souls in order to destroy in plunder;

6 therefore prophesy to the land of Israel and say to the mountains and the hills and the ravines and the valleys, Thus says the Lord: Behold, in my jealousy and in my wrath I spoke because you bore reproaches of nations;

7 therefore I will raise my hand against the nations around you; these shall receive their dishonor;

8 but your grapes and your fruit, mountains of Israel, my people shall eat, because they draw near to coming.

9 For behold, I am for you and will look upon you, and you shall be cultivated and sown.

10 And I will multiply men upon you, the whole house of Israel completely, and the cities shall be inhabited, and the desolated land shall be built up.

11 And I will multiply men and livestock upon you and settle you as at your beginning, and do good to you as in your former times; and you shall know that I am the Lord.

12 And I will bring forth men upon you, my people Israel, and they shall inherit you, and you shall be a possession for them; and you shall certainly no longer be bereaved of children by them.

13 Thus says the Lord Lord: Because they said to you, You are one devouring men, and you became bereaved of children by your nation,

14 therefore you shall no longer eat men and shall no longer bereave your nation of children, says the Lord Lord.

15 And the dishonor of nations shall no longer be heard against you, and you shall certainly not bear reproaches of peoples, says the Lord Lord.

16 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

17 Son of man, the house of Israel dwelt upon their land and defiled it in their way and in their idols and in their uncleannesses; like the uncleanness of the woman sitting apart was their way before my face.

18 And I poured out my wrath upon them,

19 and scattered them into the nations and winnowed them into the countries; according to their way and according to their sin I judged them.

20 And they entered into the nations where they entered, and profaned my holy name when it was said of them, These are the Lord's people, and they have gone out of his land.

21 And I spared them because of my holy name, which the house of Israel profaned among the nations where they entered.

22 Therefore say to the house of Israel, Thus says the Lord: I do not act for you, house of Israel, but for my holy name, which you profaned among the nations where you entered.

23 And I will sanctify my great name which was profaned among the nations, which you profaned in their midst, and the nations shall know that I am the Lord when I am sanctified in you before their eyes.

24 And I will take you out of the nations and assemble you from all the lands and bring you into your land.

25 And I will sprinkle clean water upon you, and you shall be cleansed from all your uncleannesses and from all your idols, and I will cleanse you.

26 And I will give you a new heart and put a new spirit within you, and remove the stone heart from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh.

27 And I will put my spirit within you and cause you to walk in my just requirements and keep my judgments and do them.

28 And you shall dwell upon the land which I gave to your fathers, and you shall be a people to me, and I shall be a God to you.

29 And I will save you from all your uncleannesses and call for the grain and multiply it, and I will not put famine upon you;

30 and I will multiply the fruit of the tree and the produce of the field, so that you may not receive a reproach of famine among the nations.

31 And you shall remember your evil ways and your practices which were not good, and be disgusted before their face in your lawlessnesses and over your abominations.

32 I do not act because of you, says the Lord Lord; it shall be known to you. Be ashamed and abashed because of your ways, house of Israel.

33 Thus says the Lord: On the day when I cleanse you from all your lawlessnesses, I will also settle the cities, and the desolate places shall be built up.

34 And the land which had vanished shall be cultivated, whereas it had become a vanished land before the eyes of everyone passing by.

35 And they shall say, That land which had vanished became like a garden of delight, and the desolate and vanished and demolished cities were established as fortified ones.

36 And the nations, as many as remain around you, shall know that I, the Lord, built up the demolished places and planted the vanished places; I, the Lord, have spoken and will do it.

37 Thus says the Lord: Yet for this I shall be sought by the house of Israel, to do it for them; I will multiply them, men like sheep.

38 Like holy sheep, like the sheep of Ierusalem in its feasts, so the desolate cities shall be full of flocks of men; and they shall know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 37

1 And the hand of the Lord came upon me, and the Lord brought me out in spirit and placed me in the midst of the plain, and this was full of human bones;

2 and he led me around them all about, and behold, very many upon the face of the plain, very dry.

3 And he said to me, Son of man, shall these bones live? And I said, Lord, you know these things.

4 And he said to me, Prophesy over these bones, and you shall say to them, Dry bones, hear a word of the Lord:

5 Thus says the Lord to these bones: Behold, I bring into you a spirit of life,

6 and I will put sinews upon you and bring flesh up upon you and stretch skin over you and put my spirit into you, and you shall live; and you shall know that I am the Lord.

7 And I prophesied as he commanded me. And it happened while I was prophesying, and behold, a shaking, and it brought the bones together, each to its joint.

8 And I saw, and behold, sinews and flesh were growing upon them, and skin was coming up over them above, and there was no spirit in them.

9 And he said to me, Prophesy, son of man, prophesy to the spirit and say to the spirit, Thus says the Lord: Come from the four winds and breathe into these dead ones, and let them live.

10 And I prophesied as he commanded me; and the spirit entered into them, and they lived and stood upon their feet, a very great assembly.

11 And the Lord spoke to me, saying, Son of man, these bones are the whole house of Israel, and they say, Our bones have become dry, our hope has perished, we have ceased to be heard.

12 Therefore prophesy and say, Thus says the Lord: Behold, I open your tombs and will bring you up out of your tombs and bring you into the land of Israel,

13 and you shall know that I am the Lord when I open your graves, to bring my people up out of the graves.

14 And I will put my spirit into you, and you shall live, and I will place you upon your land, and you shall know that I, the Lord, have spoken and will do it, says the Lord.

15 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

16 Son of man, take for yourself a staff and write upon it Ioudas and the sons of Israel attached to him; and you shall take for yourself a second staff and write upon it, For Ioseph, a staff of Ephraim and all the sons of Israel added to him.

17 And you shall join them to one another for yourself into one staff, to bind them, and they shall be in your hand.

18 And it shall be, when the sons of your people say to you, Will you not tell us what these things are to you?

19 that you shall say to them, Thus says the Lord: Behold, I will take the tribe of Ioseph which is through the hand of Ephraim and the tribes of Israel attached to him and put them upon the tribe of Iouda, and they shall be one staff in the hand of Iouda.

20 And the staffs upon which you wrote shall be in your hand before them,

21 and you shall say to them, Thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I take the whole house of Israel from the midst of the nations where they entered, and I will gather them from all those around them and bring them into the land of Israel;

22 and I will make them one nation in my land and in the mountains of Israel, and there shall be one ruler of them, and they shall no longer be two nations, nor shall they certainly be divided any longer into two kingdoms,

23 so that they may no longer be defiled with their idols. And I will deliver them from all their lawlessnesses in which they sinned and cleanse them, and they shall be a people to me, and I, the Lord, shall be a God to them.

24 And my servant Dauid shall be a ruler in their midst, and there shall be one shepherd of all; for they shall walk in my ordinances and keep my judgments and do them.

25 And they shall dwell upon their land which I have given to my servant Iakob, where their fathers dwelt; and they themselves shall dwell upon it, and Dauid my servant shall be their ruler forever.

26 And I will make with them a covenant of peace; an everlasting covenant shall be with them; and I will put my holy places in their midst forever.

27 And my dwelling shall be among them, and I shall be their God, and they shall be my people.

28 And the nations shall know that I am the Lord who sanctifies them, when my holy places are in their midst forever.

Chapter 38

1 And a word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 Son of man, set your face against Gog and the land of Magog, ruler of Ros, Mosoch and Thobel, and prophesy against him,

3 and say to him, Thus says the Lord Lord: Behold, I am against you, Gog, ruler of Ros, Mosoch and Thobel,

4 and I will gather you and all your force, horses and horsemen, all clothed in breastplates, a great assembly, shields and helmets and swords,

5 Persians and Ethiopians and Libyans, all with helmets and shields,

6 Gomer and all those around him, the house of Thergama from the extremity of the north and all those around him, and many nations with you;

7 be prepared, prepare yourself, you and all your assembly, those gathered with you, and you shall be an advance guard for me.

8 After many days he shall be prepared, and at the end of years he shall come and arrive at the land turned away from a sword, of those gathered from many nations, upon the land of Israel, which became wholly desolate; and this one has come out of nations, and they shall all dwell in peace.

9 And you shall go up like rain and come like a cloud to cover a land, and you shall be there, and all those around you and many nations with you.

10 Thus says the Lord Lord: And it shall be on that day, words shall come up upon your heart, and you shall devise evil thoughts,

11 and say, I will go up upon an abandoned land; I will come upon those resting in quietness and dwelling in peace, all inhabiting a land in which there is no wall or bars, and they have no doors,

12 to plunder plunder and despoil their spoils, to turn your hand upon the desolated land which was settled, and upon a nation gathered from many nations, who have acquired possessions, dwelling upon the navel of the earth.

13 Saba and Daidan and Carthaginian merchants and all their villages shall say to you, Are you coming for plunder, to plunder and despoil spoils? Have you gathered your assembly to take silver and gold, to carry away a possession, to despoil spoils?

14 Therefore prophesy, son of man, and say to Gog, Thus says the Lord: On that day, when my people Israel are settled in peace, shall you not be roused?

15 And you shall come from your place, from the extremity of the north, and many nations with you, all riders of horses, a great assembly and a large force,

16 and you shall go up against my people Israel like a cloud to cover a land; it shall be at the end of the days, and I will bring you up against my land, so that all the nations may know me when I am sanctified in you before them.

17 Thus says the Lord Lord to Gog: You are the one about whom I spoke before former days through the hand of my servants, prophets of Israel, in those days and years, to bring you against them.

18 And it shall be on that day, on the day when Gog comes against the land of Israel, says the Lord Lord, my wrath shall rise,

19 and my jealousy. In the fire of my anger I spoke: Surely on that day there shall be a great shaking upon the land of Israel,

20 and the fish of the sea and the birds of heaven and the beasts of the plain and all the creeping things creeping upon the earth and all men upon the face of the earth shall be shaken from the presence of the Lord, and the mountains shall be torn apart, and the ravines shall fall, and every wall shall fall upon the earth.

21 And I will call every terror against him, says the Lord; a man's sword shall be against his brother.

22 And I will judge him with death and blood and flooding rain and hailstones, and I will rain fire and sulfur upon him and upon all those with him and upon many nations with him.

23 And I will be magnified and sanctified and glorified and known before many nations, and they shall know that I am the Lord.

Chapter 39

1 And you, son of man, prophesy against Gog and say, Thus says the Lord: Behold, I am against you, Gog, ruler of Ros, Mosoch and Thobel,

2 and I will gather you and guide you and bring you up from the extremity of the north and lead you up onto the mountains of Israel.

3 And I will destroy your bow from your left hand and your arrows from your right hand, and cast you down

4 upon the mountains of Israel, and you shall fall, and all those around you, and the nations with you shall be given to multitudes of birds; to every winged creature and all the beasts of the plain I have given you to be devoured.

5 Upon the face of the plain you shall fall, because I have spoken, says the Lord.

6 And I will send fire upon Gog, and the islands shall be inhabited in peace; and they shall know that I am the Lord.

7 And my holy name shall be known in the midst of my people Israel, and my holy name shall no longer be profaned; and the nations shall know that I am the Lord, holy in Israel.

8 Behold, it comes, and you shall know that it shall be, says the Lord Lord; this is the day of which I spoke.

9 And those inhabiting the cities of Israel shall go out and burn with the weapons, shields and poles and bows and arrows and hand staffs and spears; and they shall burn fire with them for seven years.

10 And they shall certainly not take wood from the plain, nor shall they certainly cut it from the woods, but they shall burn the weapons with fire; and they shall plunder those who plundered them and despoil those who despoiled them, says the Lord.

11 And it shall be on that day, I will give Gog a renowned place, a memorial in Israel, the common grave of those who came against it beside the sea, and they shall build around the mouth of the ravine; and they shall bury Gog there and all his multitude, and it shall be called, The gai, the common grave of Gog.

12 And the house of Israel shall bury them, so that the land may be cleansed, in seven months;

13 and all the people of the land shall bury them, and it shall be a renown for them on the day when I was glorified, says the Lord.

14 And they shall continually assign men traversing the land to bury those remaining upon the face of the earth, to cleanse it after the seven months, and they shall search out.

15 And everyone passing through the land and seeing a human bone shall build a sign beside it, until those burying bury it in the gai, the common grave of Gog;

16 for indeed the name of the city is Common Grave; and the land shall be cleansed.

17 And you, son of man, say, Thus says the Lord: Say to every winged bird and to all the beasts of the plain, Be gathered and come, be gathered from all those round about to my sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you, a great sacrifice upon the mountains of Israel, and you shall eat flesh and drink blood.

18 You shall eat flesh of giants and drink blood of rulers of the earth, rams and calves and goats, and the calves all fattened.

19 And you shall eat fat to fullness and drink blood to drunkenness from my sacrifice which I sacrificed for you.

20 And you shall be filled at my table with horse and rider, giant and every warrior man, says the Lord.

21 And I will put my glory among you, and all the nations shall see my judgment which I executed, and my hand which I brought upon them.

22 And the house of Israel shall know that I am the Lord their God from this day and beyond.

23 And all the nations shall know that the house of Israel was taken captive because of their sins, because they rejected me, and I turned my face away from them and delivered them into the hands of their enemies, and they all fell by a sword.

24 According to their uncleannesses and according to their lawless deeds I did to them, and turned my face away from them.

25 Therefore thus says the Lord Lord: Now I will turn back the captivity of Iakob and have mercy on the house of Israel and be jealous for my holy name.

26 And they shall receive their own dishonor and the injustice which they committed, when they are settled upon their land in peace, and there shall be no one terrifying them.

27 When I turn them back from the nations and gather them from the countries of the nations, I shall also be sanctified in them before the nations,

28 and they shall know that I am the Lord their God when I appear to them among the nations.

29 And I will no longer turn my face away from them, because I poured out my wrath upon the house of Israel, says the Lord Lord.

Chapter 40

1 And it happened in the twenty-fifth year of our captivity, in the first month, on the tenth of the month, in the fourteenth year after the city was captured, on that day the hand of the Lord came upon me and brought me

2 in a vision of God into the land of Israel, and placed me upon a very high mountain, and upon it was something like a city's structure opposite.

3 And he brought me in there, and behold, a man, and his appearance was like the appearance of shining bronze, and in his hand was a builders' cord and a measuring reed, and he stood at the gate.

4 And the man said to me, Have you seen, son of man? See with your eyes and hear with your ears and set in your heart everything that I show you, because you have entered here in order that I may show you, and you shall show everything that you see to the house of Israel.

5 And behold, an enclosure outside the house round about; and in the man's hand was a reed, the measure six cubits, by a cubit and a palm, and he measured the outer wall, its breadth equal to the reed and its height equal to the reed.

6 And he entered the gate facing east by seven steps and measured the ailam of the gate, equal to the reed,

7 and the thee, equal to the reed in length and equal to the reed in breadth, and the ailam between the thaielatha, six cubits, and the second thee, equal to the reed in breadth and equal to the reed in length, and the ailam, five cubits,

8 and the third thee, equal to the reed in breadth and equal to the reed in length,

9 and the ailam of the gateway beside the ailam of the gate, eight cubits, and the aileu, two cubits, and the ailam of the gate on the inside,

10 and the thee of the gate, thee opposite, three on this side and three on that side, and one measure for the three and one measure for the ailam on this side and that side.

11 And he measured the breadth of the door of the gateway, ten cubits, and the width of the gateway, thirteen cubits,

12 and a cubit added upon the front of the theim on this side and that side, and the thee, six cubits on this side and six cubits on that side.

13 And he measured the gate from the wall of the thee to the wall of the thee, a breadth of twenty-five cubits, this gate opposite a gate;

14 and the open space of the ailam of the gate, sixty cubits, twenty theim of the gate round about;

15 and the open space of the gate outside to the open space of the ailam of the gate inside, fifty cubits;

16 and concealed windows upon the theim and upon the ailam inside the gate of the court round about, and likewise for the ailam, windows round about inside, and upon the ailam, palms on this side and that side.

17 And he brought me into the inner court, and behold, chambers and colonnades around the court, thirty chambers in the colonnades,

18 and the porticoes behind the gates, along the length of the gates, the lower colonnade.

19 And he measured the breadth of the court from the open space of the outer gate on the inside to the open space of the gate facing outside, a hundred cubits, of the one facing east. And he brought me to the north,

20 and behold, a gate facing north for the outer court, and he measured it, both its length and its breadth.

21 And its thee, three on this side and three on that side, and its aileu and its ailammo and its palms, and it came to be according to the measures of the gate facing east, fifty cubits its length and twenty-five cubits its width.

22 And its windows and its ailammo and its palms were as the gate facing east; and by seven steps they went up to it, and the ailammo were inside.

23 And a gate for the inner court faced the north gate, in the manner of the gate facing east, and he measured the court from gate to gate, a hundred cubits.

24 And he brought me southward, and behold, a gate facing south, and he measured it and the thee and the aileu and the ailammo according to these measures.

25 And its windows and the ailammo round about were as the windows of the ailam, fifty cubits its length and twenty-five cubits its width.

26 And it had seven steps, and ailammo inside, and it had palms, one on this side and one on that side, upon the aileu.

27 And a gate opposite a gate of the inner court toward the south; and he measured the court from gate to gate, a hundred cubits the width toward the south.

28 And he brought me into the inner court of the gate toward the south, and measured the gate according to these measures,

29 and the thee and the aileu and the ailammo according to these measures; and it and the ailammo had windows round about; fifty cubits its length, and the width twenty-five cubits.

31 And ailammo toward the outer court, and palms for the aileu, and eight steps.

32 And he brought me into the gate facing east and measured it according to these measures,

33 and the thee and the aileu and the ailammo according to these measures; and it and the ailammo had windows round about, fifty cubits its length and twenty-five cubits its width.

34 And ailammo toward the inner court, and palms upon the aileu on this side and that side, and it had eight steps.

35 And he brought me into the gate toward the north and measured according to these measures,

36 and the thee and the aileu and the ailammo; and it had windows round about, and its ailammo; fifty cubits its length and twenty-five cubits its width.

37 And the ailammo toward the outer court, and palms for the aileu on this side and that side, and it had eight steps.

38 Its chambers and its doorways and its ailammo were at the gate

39 of the second, a drain, so that they may slaughter in it the offerings for sin and for ignorance;

40 and behind the channel of the whole burnt offerings of the one facing north, two tables toward the east, and behind the second and the ailam of the gate, two tables eastward,

41 four on this side and four on that side behind the gate; upon them they shall slaughter the sacrifices, opposite the eight tables of the sacrifices.

42 And four tables of the whole burnt offerings, of hewn stone, a cubit and a half in breadth and two cubits and a half in length and a cubit in height; upon them they shall place the implements with which they slaughter there the whole burnt offerings and the sacrifices.

43 And they shall have a hewn cornice of a palm inside round about, and above upon the tables, roofs for shelter from rain and from dryness.

44 And he brought me into the inner court, and behold, two recesses in the inner court, one behind the gate facing north, extending toward the south, and one behind the gate toward the south but facing north.

45 And he said to me, This recess facing south is for the priests keeping the charge of the house,

46 and the recess facing north is for the priests keeping the charge of the altar; those are the sons of Saddouk who draw near from Leui to the Lord to minister to him.

47 And he measured the court, a length of a hundred cubits and a width of a hundred cubits on its four sides, and the altar opposite the house.

48 And he brought me into the ailam of the house. And he measured the ail of the ailam, five cubits the breadth on this side and five cubits on that side, and the width of the doorway, fourteen cubits, and the shoulders of the door of the ailam, three cubits on this side and three cubits on that side;

49 and the length of the ailam, twenty cubits, and the width, twelve cubits; and by ten steps they went up to it; and pillars were upon the ailam, one on this side and one on that side.

Chapter 41

1 And he brought me into the temple, for which he measured the ailam, six cubits the breadth on this side and six cubits the width of the ailam on that side,

2 and the width of the gateway, ten cubits, and the shoulders of the gateway, five cubits on this side and five cubits on that side; and he measured its length, forty cubits, and the width, twenty cubits.

3 And he entered the inner court and measured the ail of the doorway, two cubits, and the doorway, six cubits, and the shoulders of the doorway, seven cubits on this side and seven cubits on that side.

4 And he measured the length of the doors, forty cubits, and a width of twenty cubits in front of the temple. And he said, This is the holy of holies.

5 And he measured the wall of the house, six cubits, and the width of the side chamber, four cubits round about.

6 And the side chambers, side chamber upon side chamber, thirty-three twice, and a space in the wall of the house in the side chambers round about, for those taking hold to see, so that they might not touch the walls of the house at all.

7 And the width of the upper one of the side chambers was according to the addition from the wall toward the upper one around the house, so that it might widen above, and they might ascend from the lower ones to the upper rooms and from the middle ones to the third story.

8 And the thrael of the house, a height round about, a space of the side chambers equal to the reed, a space of six cubits.

9 And the width of the wall of the side chamber outside, five cubits; and the remaining spaces between the side chambers of the house

10 and between the recesses, a width of twenty cubits, the circuit around the house.

11 And the doors of the recesses opened onto the remaining space of the one door toward the north; and the one door toward the south, and the width of the opening of the remaining space, five cubits in breadth round about.

12 And the dividing structure in front of the remaining space toward the sea, seventy cubits, the breadth of the wall of the dividing structure five cubits, a width round about, and its length ninety cubits.

13 And he measured opposite the house a length of a hundred cubits, and the remaining spaces and the dividing structures and their walls, a length of a hundred cubits,

14 and the width in front of the house and the remaining spaces opposite, a hundred cubits.

15 And he measured the length of the dividing structure in front of the remaining space behind that house, and the remaining spaces on this side and that side, a hundred cubits the length. And the temple and the corners and the outer ailam

16 were paneled, and the windows latticed, openings for light round about for the three, so as to look through; and the house and the adjoining parts were covered in wood round about, and the floor, and from the floor to the windows, and the windows opening threefold for looking through.

17 And as far as beside the inner one and as far as the outer one, and upon the whole wall round about inside and outside,

18 cheroubin were carved, and palms between cheroub and cheroub; two faces for the cheroub,

19 a man's face toward the palm on this side and that side, and a lion's face toward the palm on this side and that side; the whole house was carved round about,

20 from the floor to the paneling, the cheroubin and palms carved.

21 And the holy place and the temple opened out square. Before the holy places was an appearance like the sight

22 of a wooden altar, three cubits its height, and the length two cubits and the width two cubits; and it had horns, and its base and its walls were wooden; and he said to me, This is the table before the face of the Lord.

23 And two doorways for the temple and the holy place;

24 two door leaves for the two hinged doorways, two door leaves for the one and two door leaves for the second door.

25 And carving upon them, and upon the door leaves of the temple, cheroubin and palms according to the carving of the holy places, and fine timbers in front of the ailam outside,

26 and concealed windows. And he measured on this side and that side, to the ceilings of the ailam and the joined side chambers of the house.

Chapter 42

1 And he brought me out into the outer court eastward, opposite the gate toward the north; and he brought me in, and behold, five recesses adjoining the remaining space and adjoining the dividing structure toward the north,

2 a hundred cubits in length toward the north, and the breadth fifty cubits,

3 laid out in the manner of the gates of the inner court and in the manner of the colonnades of the outer court, arranged in rows, three porticoes facing one another.

4 And opposite the recesses, a walkway ten cubits in breadth, a hundred cubits in length; and their doorways toward the north.

5 And the upper walkways likewise, because the colonnade projected from it, from the lower colonnade, and the space; thus a colonnade and a space, and thus porticoes;

6 because they were triple and did not have pillars like the pillars of the outer ones, therefore they projected beyond the lower and middle ones from the ground.

7 And an opening outside in the manner of the recesses of the outer court facing opposite the recesses toward the north, a length of fifty cubits;

8 because the length of the recesses facing into the outer court was fifty cubits, and these are facing those; the whole, a hundred cubits.

9 And the doors of these recesses of the entrance toward the east, to enter through them from the outer court,

10 were along the opening of the walkway at the beginning. – And the parts toward the south, in front of the south, in front of the remaining space and in front of the dividing structure, recesses,

11 and the walkway before them according to the measures of the recesses toward the north, and according to their length and according to their width and according to all their exits and according to all their turnings and according to their openings and according to their doorways

12 of the recesses toward the south, and according to the doorways from the beginning of the walkway, as toward an opening of a reed's space, and eastward to enter through them. –

13 And he said to me, The recesses toward the north and the recesses toward the south which are in front of the spaces, these are the recesses of the holy place, in which the priests, sons of Saddouk, who draw near to the Lord, shall eat there the holy of holies; and there they shall put the holy of holies and the sacrifice and the offerings for sin and the offerings for ignorance, because the place is holy.

14 No one shall enter there except the priests; they shall not go out from the holy place into the outer court, so that those presenting may always be holy, and may not touch their apparel in which they minister in them, because they are holy; and they shall put on other garments when they touch the people. –

15 And the measuring of the house inside was completed. And he brought me out by the way of the gate facing east and measured the outline of the house round about in order.

16 And he stood behind the gate facing east and measured five hundred with the measuring reed;

17 and he turned toward the north and measured the front toward the north, five hundred cubits with the measuring reed;

18 and he turned toward the sea and measured the front toward the sea, five hundred with the measuring reed;

19 and he turned toward the south and measured opposite the south, five hundred with the measuring reed;

20 the four sides by the same reed. And he arranged it, and their enclosure round about, five hundred eastward and five hundred cubits in width, to distinguish between the holy places and the outer wall in the arrangement of the house.

Chapter 43

1 And he brought me to the gate facing east and led me out,

2 and behold, the glory of the God of Israel was coming by the way of the gate facing east, and the sound of the camp was like the sound of many doubling their voices, and the earth shone out like brightness from the glory round about.

3 And the vision which I saw was according to the vision which I saw when I was entering to anoint the city, and the vision of the chariot which I saw was according to the vision which I saw at the river Chobar; and I fall upon my face.

4 And the glory of the Lord entered the house by the way of the gate facing east.

5 And a spirit took me up and brought me into the inner court, and behold, the house was full of the glory of the Lord.

6 And I stood, and behold, a voice from the house of one speaking to me, and the man stood beside me.

7 And he said to me, Have you seen, son of man, the place of my throne and the place of the footprint of my feet, in which my name shall dwell in the midst of the house of Israel forever? And the house of Israel shall no longer profane my holy name, they and their leaders, with their prostitution and with the murders of the leaders in their midst,

8 when they place my threshold among their thresholds and my doorposts adjoining their doorposts, and they made my wall as adjoining me and them, and profaned my holy name with their lawlessnesses which they were committing; and I crushed them in my wrath and in murder.

9 And now let them thrust their prostitution and the murders of their leaders away from me, and I will dwell in their midst forever.

10 And you, son of man, show the house to the house of Israel, and they shall cease from their sins; and its appearance and its arrangement,

11 and they themselves shall receive their punishment concerning all that they did. And you shall draw the house and its exits and its structure, and make known to them all its ordinances and all its laws, and draw it before them, and they shall keep all my just requirements and all my ordinances and do them;

12 and the drawing of the house upon the summit of the mountain, all its boundaries round about, holy of holies.

13 And these are the measures of the altar, by a cubit of a cubit and a palm; a hollow, a cubit in depth and a cubit the width, and a cornice upon its rim round about, a span. And this is the height of the altar:

14 from the depth of the beginning of its hollow to the great lower propitiatory, two cubits, and the width a cubit; and from the small propitiatory to the great propitiatory, four cubits, and a width of a cubit;

15 and the ariel, four cubits, and from the ariel and above the horns, a cubit.

16 And the ariel, twelve cubits in length by twelve cubits in breadth, square on its four sides;

17 and the propitiatory, fourteen cubits in length by fourteen cubits in width on its four sides; and its cornice circling it round about, half a cubit, and its surrounding space a cubit round about; and its steps facing east.

18 And he said to me, Son of man, thus says the Lord, the God of Israel: These are the ordinances of the altar on the day of its making, to offer whole burnt offerings upon it and pour blood against it.

19 And you shall give to the priests, the Levites from the seed of Saddouk who draw near to me, says the Lord God, to minister to me, a calf from the cattle for sin;

20 and they shall take from its blood and put it upon the four horns of the altar and upon the four corners of the propitiatory and upon the base round about, and make atonement for it;

21 and they shall take the calf for sin, and it shall be burned in the separated part of the house outside the holy places.

22 And on the second day they shall take two unblemished kids of goats for sin and make atonement for the altar as they made atonement with the calf;

23 and after you complete the atonement, they shall present an unblemished calf from the cattle and an unblemished ram from the sheep,

24 and you shall present them before the Lord, and the priests shall cast salt upon them and offer them as whole burnt offerings to the Lord.

25 For seven days you shall prepare a kid for sin each day, and a calf from the cattle and a ram from the sheep; they shall prepare unblemished ones

26 for seven days; and they shall make atonement for the altar and cleanse it and fill their hands.

27 And it shall be from the eighth day and beyond, the priests shall prepare upon the altar your whole burnt offerings and your offerings of deliverance. And I will accept you, says the Lord.

Chapter 44

1 And he turned me back by the way of the outer gate of the holy places facing east, and it was shut.

2 And the Lord said to me, This gate shall be shut; it shall not be opened, and no one shall certainly pass through it, because the Lord, the God of Israel, shall enter through it, and it shall be shut;

3 for the leader, this one shall sit in it to eat bread before the Lord; by the way of the ailam of the gate he shall enter, and by its way he shall go out. –

4 And he brought me in by the way of the gate toward the north, opposite the house, and I saw, and behold, the house of the Lord was full of glory, and I fall upon my face.

5 And the Lord said to me, Son of man, set in your heart and see with your eyes and hear with your ears everything that I speak with you, according to all the ordinances of the house of the Lord and according to all its laws; and you shall set your heart upon the entrance of the house, according to all its exits in all the holy places.

6 And you shall say to the house provoking bitterness, to the house of Israel, Thus says the Lord God: Let all your lawlessnesses suffice you, house of Israel,

7 in that you brought in foreign sons, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in my holy places, and they were profaning them when you presented bread, fat and blood, and you were transgressing my covenant in all your lawlessnesses,

8 and you appointed them to keep charges in my holy places.

9 Therefore thus says the Lord God: No foreign son, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter my holy places, among all the sons of foreigners who are in the midst of the house of Israel,

10 but only the Levites who leapt away from me when Israel went astray from me after their thoughts, and they shall receive their injustice,

11 and shall be in my holy places ministering as doorkeepers at the gates of the house and ministering to the house; these shall slaughter the whole burnt offerings and the sacrifices for the people, and these shall stand before the people to minister to them.

12 Because they were ministering to them before the face of their idols, and it became for the house of Israel a punishment for injustice, for this reason I raised my hand against them, says the Lord God,

13 and they shall not draw near to me to serve as priests to me, nor to approach the holy things of the sons of Israel, nor my holy of holies, and they shall receive their dishonor in the straying in which they strayed.

14 And they shall assign them to keep the charges of the house for all its works and for everything they may do. –

15 The priests, the Levites, the sons of Saddouk, who kept the charges of my holy places when the house of Israel went astray from me, these shall approach me to minister to me and stand before my face to present to me a sacrifice, fat and blood, says the Lord God.

16 These shall enter my holy places, and these shall approach my table to minister to me, and they shall keep my charges.

17 And it shall be, when they enter the gates of the inner court, they shall put on linen robes and shall not put on woolen ones when they minister from the gate of the inner court;

18 and they shall have linen turbans upon their heads and linen breeches upon their loins, and shall not gird themselves tightly.

19 And when they go out into the outer court to the people, they shall take off their robes in which they minister, and put them in the recesses of the holy places, and put on other robes, and shall certainly not sanctify the people with their robes.

20 And they shall not shave their heads and shall not strip their hair bare; covering, they shall cover their heads.

21 And no priest shall certainly drink wine when they enter the inner court.

22 And they shall not take for themselves as a wife a widow or a woman cast out, but only a virgin from the seed of Israel; and if a widow is left by a priest, they shall take her.

23 And they shall teach my people between holy and profane, and make known to them between unclean and clean.

24 And these shall preside over a judgment of blood, to distinguish; they shall uphold my just requirements and judge my judgments and keep my laws and my ordinances in all my feasts, and sanctify my sabbaths.

25 And they shall not come to a human soul so as to be defiled, except for his father and mother and son and daughter and brother and sister who has not become a man's wife, he shall be defiled.

26 And after he is cleansed, he shall count out seven days for himself;

27 and on the day when they enter the inner court to minister in the holy place, they shall present a propitiation, says the Lord God.

28 And it shall be an inheritance for them; I am an inheritance for them, and a possession shall not be given to them among the sons of Israel, because I am their possession.

29 And these shall eat the sacrifices and the offerings for sin and the offerings for ignorance, and everything set apart in Israel shall be theirs;

30 firstfruits of everything and the firstborn of everything and all the portions taken from all your firstfruits shall be for the priests; and you shall give your first produce to the priest, to put your blessings upon your houses.

31 And the priests shall not eat anything that has died of itself or been taken by beasts, from the birds or from the livestock.

Chapter 45

1 And when you measure out the land as an inheritance, you shall set apart a firstfruit for the Lord, holy, from the land, twenty-five thousand in length and twenty thousand in width; it shall be holy in all its boundaries round about.

2 And from this there shall be for a sanctuary five hundred by five hundred, square round about, and a space of fifty cubits for it round about.

3 And from this measurement you shall measure a length of twenty-five thousand and a width of ten thousand, and in it shall be the sanctuary, holy of holies;

4 from the land it shall be for the priests ministering in the holy place, and shall be for those drawing near to minister to the Lord, and it shall be for them a place for houses set apart for their sanctification.

5 Twenty-five thousand in length and ten thousand in width shall be for the Levites ministering to the house, for them as a possession, cities to inhabit.

6 And you shall give the possession of the city five thousand in width and twenty-five thousand in length; like the firstfruit of the holy places they shall be for the whole house of Israel.

7 And for the leader, on this side and on that side of the firstfruits of the holy places, for the possession of the city, in front of the firstfruits of the holy places and in front of the possession of the city, the parts toward the sea, and from the parts toward the sea toward the east; and the length like one of the portions from the boundaries toward the sea, and the length to the boundaries toward the east of the land;

8 and it shall be a possession for him in Israel, and the leaders of Israel shall no longer oppress my people, and the house of Israel shall inherit the land according to their tribes. –

9 Thus says the Lord God: Let it suffice you, leaders of Israel; remove injustice and misery and do judgment and righteousness, take oppression away from my people, says the Lord God.

10 Let there be for you a just balance and a just measure and a just choinix.

11 The measure and the choinix shall equally be one for receiving; the choinix a tenth of the gomor, and the measure a tenth of the gomor; it shall be equal in relation to the gomor.

12 And the weight, twenty obols; the five shekels, five, and the ten shekels, ten, and the mina shall be fifty shekels for you.

13 And this is the firstfruit which you shall set apart: a sixth of the measure from the gomor of wheat, and a sixth of the oiphi from the kor of barley.

14 And the ordinance of the oil: a kotyle of oil from ten kotylai, because the ten kotylai are a gomor.

15 And a sheep from the ten sheep, a portion taken from all the clans of Israel, for sacrifices and for whole burnt offerings and for an offering of deliverance, to make atonement for you, says the Lord God.

16 And all the people shall give this firstfruit to the leader of Israel.

17 And through the leader shall be the whole burnt offerings, and the sacrifices and the libations shall be in the feasts and in the new moons and in the sabbaths and in all the feasts of the house of Israel; he himself shall prepare the offerings for sin and the sacrifice and the whole burnt offerings and the offerings of deliverance, to make atonement for the house of Israel.

18 Thus says the Lord God: In the first month, on the first of the month, you shall take an unblemished calf from the cattle to make atonement for the holy place.

19 And the priest shall take from the blood of the atonement and put it upon the doorposts of the house and upon the four corners of the temple and upon the altar and upon the doorposts of the gate of the inner court.

20 And thus you shall do in the seventh month, on the first of the month; you shall take a portion from each one and make atonement for the house.

21 And in the first month, on the fourteenth of the month, the pascha shall be a feast for you; for seven days you shall eat unleavened things.

22 And on that day the leader shall prepare for himself and the house and for all the people of the land a calf for sin.

23 And for the seven days of the feast he shall prepare whole burnt offerings for the Lord, seven calves and seven unblemished rams each day for the seven days, and a kid of goats for sin each day.

24 And as a sacrifice you shall prepare a cake for the calf and a cake for the ram, and a hin of oil for the cake.

25 And in the seventh month, on the fifteenth of the month, at the feast you shall prepare according to the same things for seven days, as the offerings for sin and as the whole burnt offerings and as the manaa and as the oil.

Chapter 46

1 Thus says the Lord God: The gate in the inner court facing east shall be shut for the six working days, but on the day of the sabbaths it shall be opened, and on the day of the new moon it shall be opened.

2 And the leader shall enter by the way of the ailam of the gate outside and stand at the thresholds of the gate, and the priests shall prepare his whole burnt offerings and his offerings of deliverance; and he shall worship upon the threshold of the gate and go out, and the gate shall certainly not be shut until evening.

3 And the people of the land shall worship at the thresholds of that gate on the sabbaths and on the new moons before the Lord.

4 And the leader shall present the whole burnt offerings to the Lord: on the day of the sabbaths, six unblemished lambs and an unblemished ram,

5 and a manaa, a cake for the ram, and for the lambs a sacrifice, a gift of his hand, and a hin of oil for the cake;

6 and on the day of the new moon, an unblemished calf and six lambs, and a ram shall be unblemished,

7 and a cake for the ram and a cake for the calf shall be a manaa, and for the lambs as his hand may produce, and a hin of oil for the cake.

8 And when the leader enters, he shall enter by the way of the ailam of the gate, and by the way of the gate he shall go out.

9 And when the people of the land enter before the Lord in the feasts, the one entering by the way of the gate toward the north to worship shall go out by the way of the gate toward the south, and the one entering by the way of the gate toward the south shall go out by the way of the gate toward the north; he shall not return by the gate through which he entered, but shall go out straight opposite it.

10 And the leader in their midst, when they enter, shall enter with them, and when they go out, he shall go out.

11 And in the feasts and in the assemblies the manaa shall be a cake for the calf and a cake for the ram, and for the lambs as his hand may produce, and a hin of oil for the cake.

12 But if the leader makes a vow, a whole burnt offering of deliverance to the Lord, he shall also open for himself the gate facing east and prepare his whole burnt offering and his offerings of deliverance, in the manner that he does on the day of the sabbaths, and he shall go out and shut the doors after he goes out.

13 And he shall prepare an unblemished year-old lamb as a whole burnt offering each day to the Lord; in the morning he shall prepare it;

14 and he shall prepare a manaa with it in the morning, a sixth of the measure and a third of the hin of oil to mix the fine flour, a manaa for the Lord, an ordinance continually.

15 You shall prepare the lamb and the manaa, and you shall prepare the oil in the morning, a whole burnt offering continually.

16 Thus says the Lord God: If the leader gives a gift to one of his sons from his inheritance, this shall be a possession in inheritance for his sons.

17 But if he gives a gift to one of his servants, it shall also be his until the year of release, and he shall return it to the leader; except for the inheritance of his sons, it shall be theirs.

18 And the leader shall certainly not take from the inheritance of the people to oppress them; from his own possession he shall give an inheritance to his sons, so that my people may not be scattered, each from his possession.

19 And he brought me into the entrance behind the gate, into the recess of the holy places of the priests facing north, and behold, a place separated there.

20 And he said to me, This is the place where the priests shall boil there the offerings for ignorance and the offerings for sin, and there they shall bake the manaa, so as not to bring it out into the outer court at all, to sanctify the people.

21 And he brought me out into the outer court and led me around the four parts of the court, and behold, a court at the corner of the court, a court at the corner of the court;

22 at the four corners of the court, a small court, a length of forty cubits and a width of thirty cubits, one measure for the four.

23 And recesses round about in them, round about the four, and kitchens made beneath the recesses round about;

24 and he said to me, These are the houses of the kitchens, where those ministering to the house shall boil there the sacrifices of the people.

Chapter 47

1 And he brought me to the thresholds of the house, and behold, water was going out beneath the open space eastward, because the face of the house faced east, and the water was descending from the right side, from the south, upon the altar.

2 And he brought me out by the way of the gate toward the north and led me around by the way outside toward the gate of the court facing east, and behold, the water was flowing down from the right side.

3 As a man went out opposite, and a measure was in his hand, he measured a thousand with the measure, and passed through the water, water of release;

4 and he measured a thousand and passed through the water, water up to the thighs; and he measured a thousand and passed through water up to the waist;

5 and he measured a thousand and could not pass through, because the water was surging like the rush of a torrent which they shall not cross.

6 And he said to me, Have you seen, son of man? And he brought me to the bank of the river.

7 At my return, and behold, upon the bank of the river very many trees on this side and that side.

8 And he said to me, This water which goes out into Galilaia toward the east, and was descending upon Arabia and coming as far as the sea, to the water of the outlet, shall also make the waters healthy.

9 And it shall be, every soul of the living creatures swarming everywhere the river comes there shall live, and there shall be very many fish there, because this water comes there, and it shall make healthy and shall live; everything to which the river comes there shall live.

10 And fishermen shall stand there from Aingadin to Ainagalim; it shall be a drying place of nets; it shall be by itself, and its fish shall be like the fish of the great sea, a very great multitude.

11 And in its outlet and in its turning back and in its overflow they shall certainly not become healthy; they have been given over to salt.

12 And by the river, upon its bank on this side and that side, every food-bearing tree shall come up; what is upon it shall certainly not grow old, nor shall its fruit certainly fail; it shall bear first fruit in its newness, because these waters of theirs go out from the holy places, and their fruit shall be for food and their growth for health.

13 Thus says the Lord God: These boundaries you shall inherit of the land; for the twelve tribes of the sons of Israel, an addition of an allotment.

14 And you shall inherit it, each as his brother, concerning which I raised my hand to give it to their fathers, and this land shall fall to you as an inheritance.

15 And these are the boundaries of the land toward the north: from the great sea, the one descending and dividing around the entrance of Hemath, Seddada,

16 Berotha, Sebraim, Heliam, between the boundaries of Damascus and between the boundaries of Hemath, the court of Saunan, which are above the boundaries of Auranitis.

17 These are the boundaries from the sea, from the court of Ainan, the boundaries of Damascus and the parts toward the north.

18 And the parts toward the east, between Auranitis and between Damascus and between Galaaditis and between the land of Israel, the Iordanes marks the boundary to the sea toward the east of Phoinikon; these are the parts toward the east.

19 And the parts toward the south and southwest, from Thaiman and Phoinikon as far as the water of Marimoth Kades, extending to the great sea; this is the south and southwest part.

20 This is the part of the great sea; it marks the boundary as far as opposite the entrance of Hemath, as far as its entrance; these are the parts toward the sea, Hemath.

21 And you shall divide this land for them, for the tribes of Israel.

22 You shall cast it by lot for yourselves and for the sojourners dwelling among you, who begot sons in your midst; and they shall be to you like natives among the sons of Israel; with you they shall eat in inheritance in the midst of the tribes of Israel;

23 and they shall be in a tribe of sojourners, among the sojourners with them; there you shall give them an inheritance, says the Lord God.

Chapter 48

1 And these are the names of the tribes: from the beginning toward the north along the part of the descent of the dividing course to the entrance of Hemath, the court of Ainan, the boundary of Damascus toward the north along the part of the court of Hemath, and for them shall be the parts toward the east as far as toward the sea: Dan, one.

2 And from the boundaries of Dan, the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Aser, one.

3 And from the boundaries of Aser, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Nephthalim, one.

4 And from the boundaries of Nephthali, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Manasse, one.

5 And from the boundaries of Manasse, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Ephraim, one.

6 And from the boundaries of Ephraim, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Rouben, one.

7 And from the boundaries of Rouben, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Iouda, one.

8 And from the boundaries of Iouda, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea, shall be the firstfruit of the portion set apart, twenty-five thousand in width and a length like one of the portions from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea, and the holy place shall be in their midst;

9 a firstfruit which they shall set apart for the Lord, a length of twenty-five thousand and a width of twenty-five thousand.

10 Of these shall be the firstfruit of the holy places: for the priests, toward the north twenty-five thousand, and toward the sea a breadth of ten thousand, and toward the east a breadth of ten thousand, and toward the south a length of twenty-five thousand, and the mountain of the holy places shall be in its midst;

11 for the sanctified priests, sons of Saddouk, who keep the charges of the house, who did not go astray in the straying of the sons of Israel in the manner that the Levites went astray,

12 and the firstfruit given from the firstfruits of the land shall be theirs, holy of holies, from the boundaries of the Levites.

13 But for the Levites, the parts adjoining the boundaries of the priests, a length of twenty-five thousand and a width of ten thousand. The whole length twenty-five thousand and width twenty thousand.

14 None of it shall be sold or measured out, nor shall the first produce of the land be taken away, because it is holy to the Lord.

15 But the five thousand remaining in the width alongside the twenty-five thousand shall be an outer wall for the city, for dwelling and for its open space, and the city shall be in its midst.

16 And these are its measures: from the parts toward the north, four thousand five hundred, and from the parts toward the south, four thousand five hundred, and from the parts toward the east, four thousand five hundred, and from the parts toward the sea, four thousand five hundred;

17 and there shall be a space for the city toward the north, two hundred fifty, and toward the south, two hundred fifty, and toward the east, two hundred fifty, and toward the sea, two hundred fifty.

18 And the remainder of the length adjoining the firstfruits of the holy places, ten thousand toward the east and ten thousand toward the sea, and they shall be the firstfruits of the holy place, and its produce shall be for bread for those working the city;

19 and let those working the city work it, from all the tribes of Israel.

20 The whole firstfruit, twenty-five thousand by twenty-five thousand; as a square you shall set apart its firstfruit of the holy place from the possession of the city.

21 But the remainder for the leader, on this side and on that side from the firstfruits of the holy place and for the possession of the city, along twenty-five thousand in length as far as the boundaries toward the east, and toward the sea along twenty-five thousand as far as the boundaries toward the sea, adjoining the portions of the leader; and the firstfruit of the holy places and the sanctuary of the house shall be in its midst.

22 And from the possession of the Levites and from the possession of the city it shall be in the midst of the leaders; between the boundaries of Iouda and between the boundaries of Beniamin it shall belong to the leaders.

23 And the remainder of the tribes, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Beniamin, one.

24 And from the boundaries of Beniamin, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Symeon, one.

25 And from the boundaries of Symeon, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Issachar, one.

26 And from the boundaries of Issachar, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Zaboulon, one.

27 And from the boundaries of Zaboulon, from the parts toward the east as far as those toward the sea: Gad, one.

28 And from the boundaries of Gad as far as the parts toward the southwest, and its boundaries shall be from Thaiman and the water of Marimoth Kades, an inheritance as far as the great sea.

29 This is the land which you shall cast by lot for the tribes of Israel, and these are their divisions, says the Lord God.

30 And these are the exits of the city toward the north, four thousand five hundred by measure.

31 And the gates of the city are by the names of the tribes of Israel: three gates toward the north, one gate of Rouben and one gate of Iouda and one gate of Leui.

32 And the parts toward the east, four thousand five hundred; and three gates, one gate of Ioseph and one gate of Beniamin and one gate of Dan.

33 And the parts toward the south, four thousand five hundred by measure; and three gates, one gate of Symeon and one gate of Issachar and one gate of Zaboulon.

34 And the parts toward the sea, four thousand five hundred by measure; and three gates, one gate of Gad and one gate of Aser and one gate of Nephthalim.

35 A circuit of eighteen thousand. And the name of the city, from the day when it comes into being, shall be its name.

1 Susanna

Chapter 1

6 ..... and judgments came from other cities to them.

7 /8 These, seeing a woman beautiful in appearance, the wife of their brother from the sons of Israel, named Sousanna, daughter of Chelkias, wife of Ioakim, walking in her husband's paradise in the late afternoon, and desiring her,

9 perverted their mind and turned their eyes aside so as not to look into heaven or remember righteous judgments.

10 /11 And both were stricken concerning her, and neither disclosed to the other the evil possessing them concerning her, nor did the woman know this matter.

12 And when dawn came, as they came they stole a march on one another, hastening to see who would appear to her first and speak to her.

13 /14 And behold, she was walking according to her custom, and one of the elders had come, and behold, the other arrived, and one examined the other, saying, Why did you go out thus at dawn without taking me along? And each confessed his pain to the other.

19 And one said to the other, Let us go to her; and having agreed, they approached her and were trying to force her.

22 And the Jewish woman said to them, I know that if I do this, it is death for me, and if I do not do it, I shall not escape your hands;

23 but it is better for me, without doing it, to fall into your hands than to sin before the Lord.

28 But the lawbreaking men turned away, making threats among themselves and lying in wait to put her to death; and they came to the assembly of the city where they were dwelling, and all the sons of Israel who were there sat together;

29 and the two elders and judges stood up and said, Send for Sousanna daughter of Chelkias, who is the wife of Ioakim; and they immediately called her.

30 And when the woman arrived with her own father and mother, her male servants and female servants, being five hundred in number, also arrived, and the four children of Sousanna;

31 and the woman was very delicate.

32 And the lawbreakers ordered her to be uncovered, so that they might be filled with the beauty of their desire for her;

33 and all those with her wept, and everyone who knew her.

34 And the elders and judges stood up and placed their hands upon her head;

35 but her heart had trusted in the Lord her God, and looking up, she wept within herself, saying,

35 a Lord, eternal God, who knows all things before their coming into being, you know that I did not do what these lawless men wickedly devise against me. And the Lord heard her petition.

36 And the two elders said, We were walking in her husband's paradise,

37 and going around the course we saw this woman resting with a man, and standing we watched them having intercourse with one another,

38 and they did not know that we were standing there. Then we agreed with one another, saying, Let us learn who these are.

39 And approaching, we recognized her, but the young man fled, covered up,

40 and taking hold of this woman, we were questioning her, Who is the man?

41 And she did not tell us who he was. These things we testify. And the whole assembly believed them, as being elders and judges of the people.

44 /45 And behold, an angel of the Lord, while she was being led out to perish, and the angel gave, as he was commanded, a spirit of understanding to Daniel, who was younger.

48 And Daniel, separating the crowd and standing in their midst, said, So foolish, sons of Israel? Without examining or learning the clear truth, did you condemn a daughter of Israel?

51 And now separate them for me far from one another, so that I may examine them.

52 And when they were separated, Daniel said to the assembly, Now do not look to the fact that these are elders, saying, They shall certainly not lie; but I will examine them according to what occurs to me. And he called one of them, and they brought the elder to the younger man, and Daniel said to him, Hear, hear, you who have grown old in evil days; now your sins have come, which you were committing formerly,

53 entrusted to hear and judge judgments bringing death, and you condemned the innocent but released the guilty, when the Lord says, You shall not kill an innocent and righteous one;

54 now then, under what tree and in what sort of place of the paradise have you seen them being together? And the ungodly one said, Under a mastic tree.

55 And the younger man said, Rightly you have lied against your own soul; for the angel of the Lord shall split your soul today.

56 And removing this one, he said to bring the other to him; and to this one also he said, Why is your seed perverted, like Sidon's and not like Iouda's? Beauty deceived you, foul desire;

57 and thus you were doing to daughters of Israel, and they, being afraid, were having intercourse with you, but a daughter of Iouda did not endure bearing your sickness in lawlessness;

58 now then tell me, Under what tree and in what place of the garden did you catch them having intercourse with one another? And he said, Under an evergreen oak.

59 And Daniel said, Sinner, now the angel of the Lord stands holding the sword until the people utterly destroy you, to saw you apart.

60-62 And the whole assembly cried out at the younger man, as from their own mouth he had established them both as agreeing false witnesses; and as the law declares, they did to them as they had wickedly devised against the sister. And they muzzled them, and leading them out, threw them into a ravine; then the angel of the Lord cast fire through their midst. And innocent blood was saved on that day.

63 Because of this the younger ones are beloved of Iakob in their simplicity. And let us be watchful for capable younger sons; for younger ones shall act piously, and there shall be in them a spirit of knowledge and understanding forever and ever.

2 Susanna

Chapter 1

1 And there was a man dwelling in Babylon, and his name was Ioakim.

2 And he took a wife whose name was Sousanna, daughter of Chelkias, very beautiful and fearing the Lord;

3 and her parents were righteous and taught their daughter according to the law of Moyses.

4 And Ioakim was very rich, and he had a paradise adjoining his house; and the Jews came to him because he was more renowned than all.

5 And two elders from the people were appointed judges in that year, concerning whom the Master spoke, that lawlessness went out from Babylon, from elder judges who seemed to govern the people.

6 These were continually present in Ioakim's house, and all those having cases judged came to them.

7 And it happened, when the people went away at midday, Sousanna would enter and walk in her husband's paradise.

8 And the two elders watched her each day entering and walking, and came to desire her.

9 And they perverted their own mind and turned their eyes aside so as not to look into heaven or remember righteous judgments.

10 And both were stricken concerning her, and did not tell one another their pain,

11 because they were ashamed to disclose their desire, that they wanted to have intercourse with her.

12 And they were eagerly watching each day to see her.

13 And one said to the other, Let us now go home, because it is time for a meal; and going out, they separated from one another;

14 and turning back, they came to the same place, and questioning one another about the reason, they confessed their desire; and then together they appointed a time when they would be able to find her alone.

15 And it happened, while they were watching for a suitable day, she once entered, as yesterday and the third day, with only two girls, and desired to bathe in the paradise, because it was hot;

16 and no one was there except the two elders, hidden and watching her.

17 And she said to the girls, Bring me now oil and soap, and shut the doors of the paradise so that I may bathe.

18 And they did as she said and shut the doors of the paradise, and went out by the side doors to bring the things ordered them, and did not see the elders, because they were hidden.

19 And it happened, when the girls went out, the two old men also stood up and ran upon her,

20 and said, Behold, the doors of the paradise are shut, and no one sees us, and we desire you; therefore consent to us and be with us;

21 but if not, we shall testify against you that a young man was with you, and because of this you sent the girls away from you.

22 And Sousanna sighed and said, Tight places are all around me; for if I do this, it is death for me, and if I do not do it, I shall not escape your hands;

23 it is preferable for me, without doing it, to fall into your hands than to sin before the Lord.

24 And Sousanna cried out with a great voice, and the two old men also cried out against her.

25 And one ran and opened the doors of the paradise.

26 And when those from the house heard the cry in the paradise, they rushed in through the side door to see what had happened to her.

27 And when the old men spoke their words, the servants were very ashamed, because never had such a word been spoken about Sousanna.

28 And it happened on the next day, when the people assembled before her husband Ioakim, the two old men came full of the lawless intent against Sousanna to put her to death,

29 and said before the people, Send for Sousanna daughter of Chelkias, who is the wife of Ioakim; and they sent.

30 And she came, and her parents and her children and all her relatives;

31 and Sousanna was very delicate and beautiful in appearance.

32 And the lawbreakers commanded her to be uncovered, for she was covered, so that they might be filled with her beauty;

33 and those with her and all those seeing her were weeping.

34 And the two old men stood up in the midst of the people and put their hands upon her head;

35 and she, weeping, looked up into heaven, because her heart was trusting in the Lord.

36 And the old men said, While we were walking alone in the paradise, this woman entered with two maidservants and shut the doors of the paradise and dismissed the maidservants;

37 and a young man who had been hidden came to her and lay down with her.

38 And we, being in the corner of the paradise, saw the lawlessness and ran upon them;

39 and seeing them having intercourse, we were not able to gain hold of him, because he was stronger than we and had opened the doors and leapt out,

40 but taking hold of this woman, we were asking who the young man was,

41 and she did not want to tell us. These things we testify. And the assembly believed them as elders of the people and judges, and they condemned her to die.

42 And Sousanna cried out with a great voice and said, Eternal God, knower of hidden things, who knows all things before their coming into being,

43 you know that they testified false things against me; and behold, I die, having done none of the things which these wickedly devised against me.

44 And the Lord heard her voice.

45 And while she was being led away to perish, God roused the holy spirit of a younger boy whose name was Daniel,

46 and he cried out with a great voice, I am clean from this woman's blood.

47 And all the people turned to him and said, What is this word which you have spoken?

48 And he, standing in their midst, said, So foolish, sons of Israel? Without examining or learning the clear truth, did you condemn a daughter of Israel?

49 Return to the judgment seat; for these testified false things against her.

50 And all the people returned with haste. And the elders said to him, Come, sit in our midst and tell us; for God has given you the dignity of an elder.

51 And Daniel said to them, Separate them far from one another, and I will examine them.

52 And when they were separated one from the other, he called one of them and said to him, You who have grown old in evil days, now your sins have come, which you were committing formerly,

53 judging unjust judgments and condemning the innocent but releasing the guilty, when the Lord says, You shall not kill an innocent and righteous one;

54 now then, if indeed you saw this woman, say, Under what tree did you see them having intercourse with one another? And he said, Under a mastic tree.

55 And Daniel said, Rightly you have lied against your own head; for already an angel of God, having received a sentence from God, shall split you in the middle.

56 And removing him, he commanded the other to be brought forward; and he said to him, Seed of Chanaan and not of Iouda, beauty thoroughly deceived you, and desire perverted your heart;

57 thus you were doing to daughters of Israel, and they, being afraid, were having intercourse with you, but a daughter of Iouda did not endure your lawlessness;

58 now then tell me, Under what tree did you catch them having intercourse with one another? And he said, Under an evergreen oak.

59 And Daniel said to him, Rightly you too have lied against your own head; for the angel of God waits holding the sword to saw you in the middle, so that he may utterly destroy you.

60 And the whole assembly cried out with a great voice and blessed God, who saves those hoping in him.

61 And they rose against the two old men, because Daniel established from their mouth that they had testified falsely, and they did to them in the manner that they had wickedly devised for their neighbor,

62 to do according to the law of Moyses, and they killed them; and innocent blood was saved on that day.

63 And Chelkias and his wife praised God concerning their daughter Sousanna, with Ioakim her husband and all the relatives, because no shameful deed was found in her.

64 And Daniel became great before the people from that day and beyond.

1 Daniel

Chapter 1

1 In the third year of King Ioakim of Ioudaia, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon arrived at Ierusalem and was besieging it.

2 And the Lord delivered it into his hands, and Ioakim the king of Ioudaia and a certain portion of the sacred vessels of the Lord, and he carried them away to Babylon and deposited them in his idol temple.

3 And the king told Abiesdri, his own chief eunuch, to bring him from the sons of the magnates of Israel and from the royal family and from the chosen ones,

4 young men unblemished and handsome and knowledgeable in all wisdom and literate and intelligent and wise and strong, so as to be in the king's house, and to teach them letters and the Chaldean language,

5 and to give them a provision from the king's house each day, and from the royal table and from the wine which the king drinks, and to educate them for three years, and from these to set them before the king.

6 And from the family of the sons of Israel, those from Ioudaia, were Daniel, Ananias, Misael, Azarias.

7 And the chief eunuch put names upon them: upon Daniel, Baltasar, and upon Ananias, Sedrach, and upon Misael, Misach, and upon Azarias, Abdenago.

8 And Daniel considered in his heart how not to be polluted with the king's dinner and with the wine he drinks, and petitioned the chief eunuch so that he might not be defiled together with them.

9 And the Lord gave Daniel honor and favor before the chief eunuch.

10 And the chief eunuch said to Daniel, I am anxious concerning my lord the king, who has appointed your food and your drink, lest he see your faces wasted and weak beside the young men of the foreigners brought up with you, and I endanger my own neck.

11 And Daniel said to Abiesdri, who had been appointed chief eunuch over Daniel, Ananias, Misael, Azarias,

12 Test your servants now for ten days, and let some of the pulses of the earth be given to us, so as to eat and drink water;

13 and if our appearance seems wasted beside the other young men eating from the royal dinner, as you may wish, so deal with your servants.

14 And he dealt with them in this manner and tested them for ten days.

15 And after the ten days their appearance seemed beautiful and the condition of their body better than the other young men eating the royal dinner.

16 And Abiesdri was taking away their dinner and their wine, and giving them pulses instead.

17 And the Lord gave the young men knowledge and understanding and prudence in every literary art; and to Daniel he gave understanding in every word and vision and dreams and in all wisdom.

18 And after these days the king ordered them to be brought in, and they were brought by the chief eunuch to King Nabouchodonosor.

19 And the king conversed with them, and among the wise none was found like Daniel and Ananias and Misael and Azarias; and they were with the king.

20 And in every matter and understanding and education, as much as the king sought from them, he found them tenfold wiser than the sophists and philosophers in all his kingdom; and the king glorified them and appointed them rulers and designated them wise beyond all his men in affairs in all his land and in his kingdom.

21 And Daniel continued until the first year of the reign of Cyrus king of the Persians.

Chapter 2

1 And in the second year of the reign of Nabouchodonosor, it happened that the king fell into visions and dreams and was disturbed in his dream, and his sleep departed from him.

2 And the king ordered the enchanters and the magi and the sorcerers of the Chaldeans to be brought in to tell the king his dreams, and arriving, they stood beside the king.

3 And the king said to them, I have seen a dream and my spirit was moved; therefore I want to know the dream.

4 And the Chaldeans spoke to the king in Syrian, Lord king, live forever; tell your dream to your servants, and we shall explain its interpretation to you.

5 And answering, the king said to the Chaldeans, If you do not truly tell me the dream and make its interpretation clear to me, you shall be made an example, and your possessions shall be taken into the royal treasury;

6 but if you explain the dream to me and tell its interpretation, you shall receive gifts of every kind and shall be glorified by me; make the dream clear to me and interpret it.

7 And they answered a second time, saying, King, say the vision, and your servants shall interpret concerning these things.

8 And the king said to them, Truly I know that you are buying time, just as you have seen that the matter has departed from me; therefore just as I have ordered, so it shall be;

9 if you do not truly tell me the dream and make its interpretation clear, you shall fall into death; for you agreed to make false statements before me until the time is changed; now then, if you tell me the matter which I saw in the night, I shall know that you shall also make its interpretation clear.

10 And the Chaldeans answered before the king, No one of those upon the earth shall be able to tell the king what he has seen, as you ask, and every king and every ruler does not ask such a thing of any wise man and magus and Chaldean;

11 and the word which you seek, king, is difficult and extraordinary, and there is no one who shall make these things clear to the king, except perhaps an angel whose dwelling is not with any flesh; therefore it cannot happen as you suppose.

12 Then the king, becoming gloomy and deeply grieved, ordered all the wise men of Babylonia to be led out;

13 and it was decreed to kill them all, and Daniel and all those with him were sought in order to perish together.

14 Then Daniel told the counsel and opinion which he had to Arioches, the king's chief cook, whom he had ordered to lead out the sophists of Babylonia,

15 and was inquiring of him, saying, Concerning what is a decree issued bitterly by the king? Then Arioches made the ordinance known to Daniel.

16 And Daniel quickly entered before the king and petitioned that time be given him by the king, and that he might make everything clear before the king.

17 Then Daniel went away to his house and showed everything to Ananias and Misael and Azarias, his companions;

18 and he prescribed fasting and petition and seeking help from the Lord Most High concerning this mystery, so that Daniel and those with him might not be given over to destruction together with the sophists of Babylon.

19 Then in a vision in that very night the king's mystery was clearly revealed to Daniel; then Daniel blessed the Lord Most High,

20 and speaking out, said, The name of the great Lord shall be blessed forever, because wisdom and greatness are his;

21 and he changes seasons and times, removing kings and appointing them, giving wisdom to the wise and understanding to those with knowledge;

22 revealing deep and dark things, and knowing the things in darkness and the things in light, and with him is a lodging;

23 to you, Lord of my fathers, I give thanks and praise, because you gave me wisdom and prudence, and now made known to me as much as I petitioned to make clear to the king concerning these things.

24 And Daniel entered before Arioch, who had been appointed by the king to kill all the sophists of Babylonia, and said to him, Do not destroy the sophists of Babylonia, but bring me in before the king, and I will make each thing clear to the king.

25 Then Arioch hastily brought Daniel in before the king and said to him, I have found a wise man from the captivity of the sons of Ioudaia, who shall make each thing clear to the king.

26 And answering, the king said to Daniel, who was called Baltasar in Chaldean, Shall you be able to make clear to me the vision which I saw, and its interpretation?

27 And Daniel, speaking out before the king, said, The disclosure of the mystery which the king has seen does not belong to wise men and sorcerers and enchanters and Gazarenes,

28 but there is a God in heaven revealing mysteries, who made clear to King Nabouchodonosor what must happen at the end of the days. King, live forever; the dream and the vision of your head upon your bed are these.

29 You, king, lying down upon your bed, have seen everything that must happen at the end of the days, and the one revealing mysteries made clear to you what must happen.

30 And to me this mystery was not revealed because of wisdom existing in me beyond all men, but for the sake of its being made clear to the king, what you conceived in your heart was made known to me in knowledge.

31 And you, king, have seen, and behold, one image, and that image was very great, and its surpassing appearance stood before you, and the appearance of the image was fearful;

32 and its head was of fine gold, the chest and the arms silver, the belly and the thighs bronze,

33 and the legs iron, the feet partly of iron and partly earthenware.

34 You were watching until a stone was cut from a mountain without hands and struck the image upon its iron and earthenware feet and ground them down.

35 Then together the iron and the earthenware and the bronze and the silver and the gold became fine, and became as though finer than chaff on a threshing floor, and the wind blew them away so that nothing was left of them; and the stone which struck the image became a great mountain and struck all the earth.

36 This is the vision; and we shall also tell the interpretation before the king.

37 You, king, are a king of kings, and to you the Lord of heaven gave dominion and kingdom and strength and honor and glory,

38 in the whole inhabited world, from men and wild beasts and birds of heaven and the fish of the sea, he delivered under your hands to rule over all; you are the golden head.

39 And after you a kingdom less than you shall arise, and a third, another bronze kingdom, which shall rule over all the earth.

40 And a fourth kingdom, strong like iron which subdues everything and cuts down every tree, and all the earth shall be shaken.

41 And as you have seen its feet partly of potter's earthenware and partly of iron, another kingdom shall be in it, in two parts, just as you saw the iron mixed together with the clay earthenware;

42 and the toes of the feet partly iron and partly earthenware, a certain part of the kingdom shall be strong and a certain part shall be shattered.

43 And as you saw the iron mixed together with the clay earthenware, they shall be mingled in the generation of men, but shall not be of one mind or well disposed to one another, just as neither can iron be blended with earthenware.

44 And in the times of these kings the God of heaven shall establish another kingdom, which shall exist forever and shall not be destroyed, and this kingdom shall certainly not permit another nation, but shall strike and make these kingdoms disappear, and shall itself stand forever,

45 just as you have seen a stone cut from a mountain without hands, and it crushed together the earthenware, the iron and the bronze and the silver and the gold. The great God made known to the king the things that shall be at the end of the days, and the vision is exact, and its interpretation trustworthy.

46 Then King Nabouchodonosor fell upon his face to the ground and worshiped Daniel, and ordered sacrifices and libations to be made for him.

47 And the king, speaking out to Daniel, said, Truly your God is a God of gods and Lord of kings, who alone reveals hidden mysteries, because you were able to make this mystery clear.

48 Then King Nabouchodonosor exalted Daniel and gave great and many gifts and appointed him over the affairs of Babylonia and designated him ruler and leader of all the sophists of Babylonia.

49 And Daniel petitioned the king that Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago be appointed over the affairs of Babylonia; and Daniel was in the royal court.

Chapter 3

1 In the eighteenth year, King Nabouchodonosor, governing cities and countries and all those dwelling upon the earth from India to Ethiopia, made a golden image, its height sixty cubits and its breadth six cubits, and set it in a plain of the enclosure of the country of Babylonia.

2 And Nabouchodonosor, king of kings and ruling over the whole inhabited world, sent to gather together all the nations and tribes and tongues, satraps, generals, local rulers and consuls, administrators and those in authority by country, and all those throughout the inhabited world, to come to the dedication of the golden image which King Nabouchodonosor set up;

3 and those written before stood opposite the image.

4 And the herald proclaimed to the crowds, It is commanded you, nations and countries, peoples and tongues:

5 when you hear the sound of the trumpet, pipe and lyre, sambyke and psaltery, symphony and every kind of musical instrument, fall down and worship the golden image which King Nabouchodonosor set up;

6 and everyone who does not fall down and worship, they shall throw him into the burning furnace of fire.

7 And at that time, when all the nations heard the sound of the trumpet and every sound of musical instruments, all the nations, tribes and tongues fell down and worshiped the golden image which Nabouchodonosor set up, before it.

8 At that time Chaldean men approached and accused the Jews,

9 and taking up the matter, said, Lord king, live forever;

10 you, king, ordered and decreed that every man who hears the sound of the trumpet and every sound of musical instruments should fall down and worship the golden image,

11 and whoever does not fall down and worship shall be thrown into the burning furnace of fire;

12 but there are certain Jewish men whom you appointed over the country of Babylonia, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago; those men did not fear your command and did not serve your idol and did not worship your golden image which you set up.

13 Then Nabouchodonosor, enraged with anger, ordered Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago to be brought; then the men were brought before the king.

14 And seeing them together, King Nabouchodonosor said to them, Why, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, do you not serve my gods and not worship the golden image which I set up?

15 And now, if indeed you are ready, upon hearing the trumpet and every sound of musical instruments, to fall down and worship the golden image which I set up; but if indeed not, know that if you do not worship, you shall immediately be thrown into the burning furnace of fire; and what god shall rescue you from my hands?

16 And answering, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago said to King Nabouchodonosor, King, we have no need to answer you concerning this command;

17 for there is a God in the heavens, one Lord of ours whom we fear, who is able to rescue us from the furnace of fire, and from your hands, king, he shall rescue us;

18 and then it shall be evident to you that we neither serve your idol nor worship your golden image which you set up.

19 Then Nabouchodonosor was filled with wrath, and the form of his face was changed, and he ordered the furnace to be heated sevenfold beyond what it ought to be heated;

20 and he ordered the strongest men in the force to bind Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago together and throw them into the burning furnace of fire.

21 Then those men were bound together, having their footwear and their tiaras upon their heads with their clothing, and were thrown into the furnace.

22 Since the king's ordinance was urgent and the furnace was heated sevenfold beyond its former heat, the men appointed bound them together and brought them to the furnace and threw them into it.

23 So the flame, coming out of the furnace, burned and killed the men who bound those with Azarias together, but they themselves were preserved.

24 Thus then Ananias and Azarias and Misael prayed and sang a hymn to the Lord when the king ordered them to be thrown into the furnace.

25 And Azarias stood and prayed thus, and opening his mouth, was giving thanks to the Lord together with his companions in the midst of the fire, while the furnace was heated greatly by the Chaldeans, and they said,

26 Blessed are you, Lord, the God of our fathers, and praiseworthy and glorified is your name forever,

27 because you are righteous in everything you did to us, and all your works are true, and your ways straight, and all your judgments true,

28 and you executed judgments of truth according to everything you brought upon us and upon your holy city of our fathers, Ierusalem, because in truth and judgment you did all these things because of our sins.

29 For we sinned in everything and acted lawlessly in departing from you, and sinned greatly in everything, and did not obey the commandments of your law,

30 nor preserve them nor do as you commanded us, so that it might go well for us.

31 And now everything you brought upon us and everything you did to us, you did in true judgment,

32 and delivered us into the hands of our lawless enemies and most hostile apostates, and to an unjust king, most wicked beyond all the earth.

33 And now we cannot open our mouth; shame and reproach have come to your servants and to those revering you.

34 Do not deliver us up completely because of your name, and do not scatter your covenant,

35 and do not remove your mercy from us because of Abraam, beloved by you, and because of Isaak your servant and Israel your holy one,

36 as you spoke to them, saying that you would multiply their seed like the stars of heaven and like the sand beside the shore of the sea.

37 For, Master, we have been made smaller than all the nations, and are lowly in all the earth today because of our sins,

38 and at this time there is no ruler or prophet or leader or whole burnt offering or sacrifice or offering or incense or place to offer fruit before you and find mercy;

39 but with a shattered soul and humbled spirit may we be accepted, as with whole burnt offerings of rams and bulls and as with myriads of fat lambs;

40 thus let our sacrifice be before you today, and make atonement behind you, because there is no shame for those trusting in you, and bring to completion behind you.

41 And now we follow with a whole heart and fear you and seek your face; do not put us to shame,

42 but deal with us according to your clemency and according to the multitude of your mercy,

43 and rescue us according to your wonders, and give glory to your name, Lord.

44 And may all those displaying evils to your servants be abashed and put to shame from all their dominion, and may their strength be shattered;

45 let them know that you alone are Lord God and glorious over the whole inhabited world.

46 And the king's attendants who threw them in did not cease heating the furnace. And when they threw the three into the furnace at once, and the furnace was red-hot in its heat sevenfold, and when they threw them in, those throwing them in were above them, and the others were burning naphtha and tow and pitch and vine branches beneath them.

47 And the flame spread above the furnace for forty-nine cubits,

48 and went through and burned those of the Chaldeans whom it found around the furnace.

49 But an angel of the Lord descended together with those with Azarias into the furnace and shook the flame of fire out of the furnace,

50 and made the midst of the furnace like a whistling breeze of dew, and the fire did not touch them at all and did not hurt or trouble them.

51 And the three, taking up the song as from one mouth, were singing hymns and glorifying and blessing and exalting God in the furnace, saying,

52 Blessed are you, Lord, the God of our fathers, and praiseworthy and highly exalted forever, and blessed is the holy name of your glory, and exceedingly praiseworthy and highly exalted for all ages.

53 Blessed are you in the temple of your holy glory, and exceedingly hymned and exceedingly glorious forever.

54 Blessed are you upon the throne of your kingdom, and hymned and highly exalted forever.

55 Blessed are you who looks upon abysses, seated upon cheroubim, and praiseworthy and glorified forever.

56 Blessed are you in the firmament, and hymned and glorified forever.

57 Bless the Lord, all the works of the Lord; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

58 Bless the Lord, angels of the Lord; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

59 Bless the Lord, heavens; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

60 Bless the Lord, all waters above heaven; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

61 Bless the Lord, all the powers of the Lord; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

62 Bless the Lord, sun and moon; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

63 Bless the Lord, stars of heaven; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

64 Bless the Lord, every shower and dew; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

65 Bless the Lord, all winds; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

66 Bless the Lord, fire and heat; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

67 Bless the Lord, chill and cold; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

68 Bless the Lord, dews and snowfalls; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

69 Bless the Lord, frosts and cold; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

70 Bless the Lord, hoarfrosts and snows; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

71 Bless the Lord, nights and days; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

72 Bless the Lord, light and darkness; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

73 Bless the Lord, lightnings and clouds; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

74 Let the earth bless the Lord; let it sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

75 Bless the Lord, mountains and hills; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

76 Bless the Lord, everything growing upon the earth; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

77 Bless the Lord, springs; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

78 Bless the Lord, seas and rivers; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

79 Bless the Lord, sea monsters and all things moving in the waters; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

80 Bless the Lord, all birds of heaven; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

81 Bless the Lord, quadrupeds and beasts of the earth; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

82 Bless the Lord, sons of men; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

83 Bless the Lord, Israel; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

84 Bless the Lord, priests; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

85 Bless the Lord, servants; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

86 Bless the Lord, spirits and souls of righteous ones; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

87 Bless the Lord, holy ones and humble in heart; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever.

88 Bless the Lord, Ananias, Azarias, Misael; sing hymns and highly exalt him forever, because he rescued us from Hades and saved us from the hand of death and delivered us from the midst of a burning flame and redeemed us from the fire.

89 Give thanks to the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is forever.

90 Bless, all those revering the God of gods; sing hymns and give thanks, because his mercy is forever and forever and ever.

91 And it happened when the king heard them singing hymns, and standing, he watched them alive, then King Nabouchodonosor marveled and rose hastily and said to his friends,

92 Behold, I see four men unbound walking in the fire, and no destruction has occurred in them, and the appearance of the fourth is the likeness of an angel of God.

93 And the king approached the door of the furnace [which was] burning with fire and called them by name, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, servants of the Most High God of gods, come out of the fire. Thus then the men came out from the midst of the fire.

94 And the consuls, local rulers and chiefs of clans and the king's friends were gathered, and watched those men, that the fire did not touch their body, and their hair was not burned, and their trousers were not changed, nor was a smell of fire in them.

95 And King Nabouchodonosor took up the matter and said, Blessed is the Lord, the God of Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, who sent his angel and saved his servants who hoped in him, for they rejected the king's command and delivered their bodies to burning, so that they might not serve or worship any other god except their God;

96 and now I decree that every nation and all tribes and all tongues, whoever blasphemes against the Lord, the God of Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, shall be dismembered and his house confiscated, because there is no other god who shall be able to rescue thus.

97 Thus then the king gave authority to Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago over the whole country and appointed them rulers.

4 In the eighteenth year of the reign of Nabouchodonosor he said, I was at peace in my house and flourishing upon my throne.

5 I saw a dream and became apprehensive, and fear fell upon me.

10 I was sleeping, and behold, a high tree growing upon the earth; its appearance great, and there was no other like it.

12 Its branches in length were about thirty stadia, and beneath it all the beasts of the earth took shade, and in it the birds of heaven nested; its fruit was abundant and good, and supplied all the living creatures.

11 And its appearance was great; its top reached as far as heaven, and its bulk as far as the clouds, filling the things beneath heaven; the sun and the moon dwelt in it and illuminated all the earth.

13 I was watching in my sleep, and behold, an angel was sent in strength from heaven,

14 and he called out and said to it, Cut it down and destroy it; for it has been ordered by the Most High to uproot it and make it useless.

15 And thus he said, Leave one root of it in the earth, so that with the beasts of the earth in the mountains he may graze grass like an ox;

16 and his body may be changed by the dew of heaven, and for seven years he may be fed with them,

17 until he knows that the Lord of heaven has authority over everything in heaven and upon the earth, and does among them whatever he wishes.

17 a Before me it was cut down in one day, and its destruction in one hour of the day, and its branches were given to every wind, and it was dragged and thrown down; and he was eating the grass of the earth with the beasts of the earth, and was delivered into custody, and was bound by them in fetters and bronze handcuffs. I greatly marveled at all these things, and my sleep departed from my eyes.

18 And rising in the morning from my bed, I called Daniel, the ruler of the sophists and the leader of those interpreting dreams, and related the dream to him, and he showed me its whole interpretation.

19 And Daniel marveled greatly, and suspicion pressed upon him, and becoming afraid, trembling taking him and his appearance changing, shaking his head, for one hour he was astonished and answered me with a gentle voice, King, may this dream come upon those hating you, and its interpretation upon your enemies.

20 The tree planted in the earth, whose appearance is great, is you, king.

21 And all the birds of heaven nesting in it: the strength of the earth and of the nations and of all the tongues as far as the ends of the earth, and all the countries serve you.

22 And that that tree was raised high and drew near to heaven and its bulk touched the clouds: you, king, were raised high above all men upon the face of all the earth; your heart was exalted with arrogance and strength concerning the Holy One and his angels; your works were seen, because you desolated the house of the living God on account of the sins of the sanctified people.

23 And the vision which you saw, that an angel was sent in strength from the Lord, and that he said to remove the tree and cut it down: the judgment of the great God shall come upon you,

24 and the Most High and his angels run against you;

25 they shall lead you away into custody and send you into a deserted place.

26 And the root of the tree left, since it was not uprooted: the place of your throne shall be preserved for you for a season and an hour. Behold, they prepare against you and shall scourge you and bring upon you the things judged.

27 The Lord lives in heaven, and his authority is over all the earth; petition him concerning your sins, and redeem all your injustices with alms, so that clemency may be given you and you may be long-lived upon the throne of your kingdom, and he may not destroy you. Love these words; for my word is exact, and your time full.

28 And at the completion of the words, Nabouchodonosor, when he heard the interpretation of the vision, kept the words in his heart. –

29 And after twelve months the king was walking upon the walls of the city with all his glory and passing upon its towers,

30 and answering, said, This is great Babylon, which I built, and it shall be called the house of my kingdom by the strength of my might, for the honor of my glory.

31 And at the completion of his word he heard a voice from heaven, To you it is said, King Nabouchodonosor, the kingdom of Babylon has been taken from you and is given to another, a despised man in your house; behold, I appoint him over your kingdom, and he shall receive your authority and your glory and your luxury, so that you may know that the God of heaven has authority in the kingdom of men, and to whomever he wishes he shall give it; and by sunrise another king shall rejoice in your house and possess your glory and your strength and your authority.

32 And the angels shall pursue you for seven years, and you shall certainly not be seen, nor shall you certainly speak with any man; they shall feed you grass like an ox, and your pasture shall be from the greenery of the earth; behold, in place of your glory they shall bind you, and another shall have the house of your luxury and your kingdom.

33 And by morning everything shall be accomplished upon you, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, and nothing of all these things shall fall short. –

33 a I, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon, was bound for seven years; they fed me grass like an ox, and I ate from the greenery of the earth. And after seven years I gave my soul to petition and pleaded concerning my sins before the Lord, the God of heaven, and concerning my ignorances I petitioned the great God of gods.

34 And my hair became like an eagle's wings, my nails like a lion's; my flesh and my heart were changed, I walked naked with the beasts of the earth. I saw a dream, and suspicions have seized me, and after a time much sleep took me and drowsiness fell upon me. And at the completion of the seven years my time of redemption came, and my sins and my ignorances were fulfilled before the God of heaven; and concerning my ignorances I petitioned the great God of gods, and behold, one angel called me from heaven, saying, Nabouchodonosor, serve the holy God of heaven and give glory to the Most High; the kingdom of your nation is restored to you.

36 At that time my kingdom was restored to me, and my glory was returned to me.

37 I give thanks to the Most High and praise the one who created heaven and earth and the seas and the rivers and everything in them; I give thanks and praise, because he is God of gods and Lord of lords and King of kings, because he performs signs and wonders and changes seasons and times, removing the kingdom of kings and appointing others instead of them.

37 a From now on I will serve him, and from fear of him trembling has seized me, and I praise all his holy ones; for the gods of the nations do not have strength in themselves to turn a king's kingdom to another king, and to kill and make alive and perform signs and great and fearful wonders and change exceedingly great affairs, as the God of heaven did in me and changed great affairs concerning me. All the days of my kingdom I will present sacrifices concerning my soul to the Most High, for a fragrant odor to the Lord, and do what is pleasing before him, I and my people, my nation and my countries in my authority. And as many as spoke against the God of heaven, and as many as are caught saying anything, these I will condemn to death. –

38 And King Nabouchodonosor wrote a circular letter to all the nations by place and countries and all tongues dwelling in all the countries, through generations and generations: Praise the Lord, the God of heaven, and present sacrifice and offering to him gloriously; I, king of kings, give thanks to him gloriously, because he did thus with me; on that very day he seated me upon my throne, and I gained possession of my authority and my kingdom among my people, and my greatness was restored to me.

39 King Nabouchodonosor to all nations and all countries and all those dwelling in them: May peace be multiplied to you at every time. And now I will show you the deeds which the great God did with me; and it seemed good to me to demonstrate to you and to your sophists that there is a God, and his wonders are great, his kingdom a kingdom forever, his authority from generations to generations. And he sent letters concerning everything that had happened to him in his kingdom to all the nations under his kingdom.

Chapter 5

1 t King Baltasar made a great reception on the day of the dedication of his royal palaces, and called two thousand men from his magnates. On that day Baltasar, exalted by the wine and boasting, praised all the gods of the nations, the cast and carved ones in his place, and did not give praise to God Most High. In that very night fingers like a man's came out and inscribed upon the wall of his house, upon the plaster opposite the lamp, Mane phares thekel. And their interpretation is: mane, it has been numbered; phares, it has been removed; thekel, it has been weighed.

1 King Baltasar made a great banquet for his companions and was drinking wine.

2 And his heart was exalted, and he said to bring the gold and silver vessels of the house of God which Nabouchodonosor his father brought from Ierusalem, and to pour wine in them for his companions.

3 And they were brought, and they were drinking in them,

4 and blessing their handmade idols, and did not bless the eternal God who has authority over their spirit.

5 In that very hour fingers like those of a man's hand came out and wrote upon the wall of his house, upon the plaster opposite the light, before King Baltasar, and he saw a hand writing.

6 And his appearance was changed, and fears and suspicions were pressing upon him. So the king hastened and stood up and was looking at that writing, and the companions around him were boasting.

7 And the king called out with a great voice to summon the enchanters and sorcerers and Chaldeans and Gazarenes to announce the interpretation of the writing. And they were entering to inspect and see the writing, and could not interpret the interpretation of the writing for the king. Then the king issued an ordinance, saying, Every man who shows the interpretation of the writing, he shall clothe him in purple and put a golden necklace upon him, and authority over the third part of the kingdom shall be given to him.

8 And the enchanters and sorcerers and Gazarenes were entering, and no one could announce the interpretation of the writing.

9 Then the king called the queen concerning the sign and showed her how great it was, and that no man could announce to the king the interpretation of the writing.

10 Then the queen mentioned to him Daniel, who was from the captivity of Ioudaia,

11 and said to the king, The man was knowledgeable and wise and surpassing all the wise men of Babylon,

12 and a holy spirit is in him, and in the days of your father the king he showed extraordinary interpretations to Nabouchodonosor your father.

13 Then Daniel was brought before the king, and answering, the king said to him,

16 O Daniel, can you show me the interpretation of the writing? And I will clothe you in purple and put a golden necklace upon you, and you shall have authority over the third part of my kingdom.

17 Then Daniel stood opposite the writing and read, and thus answered the king, This is the writing: It has been numbered, reckoned, removed; and the hand which wrote stood still. And this is their interpretation.

23 King, you made a banquet for your friends and were drinking wine, and the vessels of the house of the living God were brought to you, and you were drinking in them, you and your magnates, and praised all the handmade idols of men; and you did not bless the living God, and your spirit is in his hand, and he himself gave you your kingdom, and you did not bless him or praise him.

26-28 This is the interpretation of the writing: Your time of the kingdom has been numbered, your kingdom is ending, your kingdom has been cut short and completed, it is given to the Medes and the Persians.

29 Then King Baltasar clothed Daniel in purple and put a golden necklace upon him and gave him authority over the third part of his kingdom.

30 And the interpretation came upon King Baltasar, and the kingdom has been removed from the Chaldeans and was given to the Medes and the Persians.

Chapter 6

1 And Artaxerxes of the Medes received the kingdom. And Dareios was full of days and glorious in old age;

2 and he appointed a hundred twenty-seven satraps over all his kingdom,

3 and over them three men as their leaders, and Daniel was one of the three men,

4 having authority above all in the kingdom. And Daniel was clothed in purple and great and glorious before King Dareios, because he was glorious and knowledgeable and intelligent, and a holy spirit was in him, and he prospered in the king's affairs which he conducted. Then the king resolved to appoint Daniel over all his kingdom, and the two men whom he appointed with him, and a hundred twenty-seven satraps.

5 And when the king resolved to appoint Daniel over all his kingdom, then the two young men devised a counsel and opinion among themselves, speaking to one another, since they found no sin or ignorance against Daniel concerning which they might accuse him before the king,

6 and said, Come, let us establish a decree among ourselves, that no man shall make a request and shall certainly not pray a prayer to any god for thirty days, but only to King Dareios; but if not, he shall die; so that they might overcome Daniel before the king, and he might be thrown into the pit of the lions. For they knew that Daniel prays and petitions the Lord his God three times a day.

7 Then those men approached and said before the king,

8 We have established a decree and enactment, that every man who prays a prayer or makes any request to any god for thirty days, except to King Dareios, shall be thrown into the pit of the lions.

9 And they petitioned the king to establish the decree and not change it, because they knew that Daniel prays and petitions three times a day, so that he might be overcome through the king and thrown into the pit of the lions.

10 And thus King Dareios established and ratified it.

11 And Daniel, learning the decree which he established against him, opened windows in his upper room opposite Ierusalem, and would fall upon his face three times a day, as he did formerly, and petition.

12 And they watched Daniel and caught him praying three times a day each day.

13 Then these men appealed to the king and said, King Dareios, did you not issue a decree that no man should pray a prayer or make a request to any god for thirty days, but to you, king; but if not, he shall be thrown into the pit of the lions? And answering, the king said to them, The word is exact, and the decree shall remain.

13 a And they said to him, We adjure you by the decrees of the Medes and Persians not to change the ordinance or show partiality, and not to diminish anything of what has been said, and to punish the man who did not abide by this decree. And he said, Thus I will do as you say, and this stands for me.

14 And they said, Behold, we found Daniel your friend praying and petitioning the face of his God three times a day.

15 And the king, grieving, said that Daniel should be thrown into the pit of the lions according to the decree which he established against him. Then the king was greatly grieved over Daniel and was helping to rescue him from the hands of the satraps until sunset,

16 and could not rescue him from them.

17 And King Dareios cried out and said to Daniel, Your God, whom you serve continually three times a day, he himself shall rescue you from the hand of the lions; until morning take courage.

18 Then Daniel was thrown into the pit of the lions, and a stone was brought and placed at the mouth of the pit, and the king sealed it with his own ring and with the rings of his magnates, so that Daniel might not be taken away by them, or the king draw him up out of the pit.

19 Then the king returned to his royal palaces and spent the night fasting, and was grieving concerning Daniel. Then the God of Daniel, exercising providence for him, shut the mouths of the lions, and they did not trouble Daniel.

20 And King Dareios rose early in the morning and took the satraps with him, and going, stood at the mouth of the pit of the lions.

21 Then the king called Daniel with a great voice, with weeping, saying, O Daniel, are you indeed alive, and has your God whom you serve continually saved you from the lions, and have they not destroyed you?

22 Then Daniel answered with a great voice and said, King, I am still living,

23 and God has saved me from the lions, because righteousness was found in me before him; and before you also, king, neither ignorance nor sin was found in me; but you listened to men misleading kings and threw me into the pit of the lions for destruction.

24 Then all the forces were gathered and saw Daniel, how the lions did not trouble him.

25 Then those two men who testified against Daniel, they and their wives and their children, were thrown to the lions, and the lions killed them and crushed their bones.

26 Then Dareios wrote to all nations and countries and tongues, to those dwelling in all his land, saying,

27 Let all men in my kingdom worship and serve the God of Daniel, for he is God, enduring and living through generations of generations forever;

28 I, Dareios, shall worship and serve him all my days, for handmade idols cannot save as the God of Daniel redeemed Daniel.

29 And King Dareios was added to his family, and Daniel was appointed over the kingdom of Dareios; and Cyrus the Persian received his kingdom.

Chapter 7

1 In the first year of Baltasar reigning over the country of Babylonia, Daniel saw a vision beside his head upon his bed; then Daniel wrote the vision which he saw in headings of words:

2 Upon my bed I was watching during sleeps of the night, and behold, four winds of heaven fell upon the great sea.

3 And four beasts were coming up out of the sea, differing one from another.

4 The first was like a lioness having wings like an eagle's; I was watching until its wings were plucked, and it was lifted from the earth and stood upon human feet, and a human heart was given to it.

5 And behold, after it another beast having a likeness of a bear, and it stood upon one side, and three ribs were in its mouth, and thus he said, Rise, devour much flesh.

6 And after these things I was watching another beast like a leopard, and four wings were stretching out above it, and the beast had four heads, and a tongue was given to it.

7 And after these things I was watching in a vision of the night a fourth beast, fearful, and its terror surpassing in strength, having great iron teeth, eating and pounding, trampling round about with its feet, acting differently from all the beasts before it; and it had ten horns,

8 and many counsels in its horns. And behold, another single horn grew up among them, small among its horns, and three of the first horns were dried up through it; and behold, eyes like human eyes in this horn, and a mouth speaking great things, and it was making war against the holy ones.

9 I was watching until thrones were placed, and an ancient of days was seated, having a garment like snow, and the hair of his head like clean white wool, the throne like a flame of fire,

10 and a river of fire was going out before his face; a thousand thousands were attending him and ten thousand ten thousands stood beside him; and a court sat, and books were opened.

11 I was watching then the sound of the great words which the horn was speaking, and the beast was beaten to death, and its body perished and was given to burning with fire.

12 And he removed those around it from their authority, and a time of life was given to them until a time and season.

13 I was watching in a vision of the night, and behold, upon the clouds of heaven one like a son of man was coming, and he was present as an ancient of days, and those standing beside were present to him.

14 And authority was given to him, and all the nations of the earth according to families and all glory were serving him; and his authority is an everlasting authority which shall certainly not be taken away, and his kingdom one which shall certainly not be destroyed. –

15 And I, Daniel, becoming distressed at these things in the vision of the night,

16 approached one of those standing and was seeking from him the exact truth concerning all these things. And answering, he speaks to me and made clear to me the interpretation of the words:

17 These great beasts are four kingdoms which shall perish from the earth;

18 and holy ones of the Most High shall receive the kingdom and possess the kingdom forever and forever and ever.

19 Then I wanted to ascertain exactly concerning the fourth beast, destroying everything and exceedingly fearful, and behold, its teeth iron and its claws bronze, devouring everyone round about and trampling with its feet,

20 and concerning its ten horns upon its head and the other one which grew up, and three fell out through it, and that horn had eyes and a mouth speaking great things, and its appearance surpassed the others.

21 And I was observing that horn engaging in war against the holy ones and routing them,

22 until the ancient of days came, and he gave judgment to the holy ones of the Most High, and the season was given, and the holy ones possessed the kingdom.

23 And it was said to me concerning the fourth beast, that a fourth kingdom shall be upon the earth, which shall differ beyond all the earth and overturn it and grind it down.

24 And the ten horns of the kingdom, ten kings shall stand, and the other king shall stand after these, and he shall differ in evils beyond the first and humble three kings;

25 and he shall speak words against the Most High and wear down the holy ones of the Most High and expect to change seasons and law, and everything shall be delivered into his hands until a season and seasons and until half a season.

26 And the judgment shall sit, and they shall destroy the authority and resolve to defile and destroy until the end.

27 And he gave the kingdom and authority and their magnificence and the dominion of all the kingdoms under heaven to a holy people of the Most High, to reign an everlasting kingdom, and all [the] authorities shall be subjected to him and obey him.

28 Until the conclusion of the word I, Daniel, was greatly held in consternation, and my condition changed for me, and I fixed the matter in my heart.

Chapter 8

1 In the third year of Baltasar reigning, a vision which I, Daniel, saw after I saw the first.

2 And I saw in the vision of my dream, while I was in the city of Sousa, which is in the country of Elymais, while I was still beside the gate Ailam,

3 looking up, I saw one great ram standing opposite the gate, and it had horns, and one higher than the other, and the higher one was rising.

4 And after these things I saw the ram butting toward the east and toward the north and toward the west and south, and all the beasts did not stand before it, and there was no one delivering from its hands, and it did as it wished and was exalted.

5 And I was considering, and behold, a male goat was coming from the west upon the face of the earth and was not touching the earth, and the goat had one horn between its eyes.

6 And it came against the ram having the horns which I saw standing beside the gate, and ran toward it in wrathful anger.

7 And I saw it approaching the ram, and it became enraged against it and struck and shattered its two horns, and there was no longer strength in the ram to stand opposite the goat; and it dashed it to the earth and shattered it, and there was no one delivering the ram from the goat.

8 And the male goat grew exceedingly strong, and when it grew strong, its great horn was shattered, and four other horns came up behind it toward the four winds of heaven.

9 And from one of them one strong horn grew up and grew strong and struck toward the south and toward the east and toward the north;

10 and it was raised high as far as the stars of heaven, and was dashed to the earth by the stars and trampled by them,

11 until the chief commander delivers the captivity, and through him the mountains from of old were dashed down, and their place and sacrifice were removed, and he placed it down upon the earth, and it became fragrant and came to be, and the holy place shall be desolated;

12 and sins came upon the sacrifice, and righteousness was thrown to the ground, and it acted and became fragrant.

13 And I was hearing another holy one speaking, and the other said to the phelmouni who was speaking, Until when shall the vision stand, and the sacrifice which was taken away and the sin of desolation which was given, and shall the holy places be desolated for trampling?

14 And he said to him, Until evening and morning, two thousand three hundred days, and the holy place shall be cleansed.

15 And it happened while I was watching, I, Daniel, was seeking to understand the vision, and behold, one stood opposite me like the appearance of a man.

16 And I heard a man's voice in the midst of Oulai, and he called and said, Gabriel, make that one understand the vision. And crying out, the man said, The vision pertains to that ordinance.

17 And he came and stood beside my position, and when he came I was alarmed and fell upon my face, and he said to me, Understand, son of man, for this vision is yet for an hour of a season.

18 And while he spoke with me, I fell asleep upon my face to the ground, and touching me, he raised me upon the place,

19 and said to me, Behold, I tell you what shall be at the end of the anger for the sons of your people; for it shall yet remain for hours of a season of completion.

20 The ram which you saw, which has the horns, is a king of Medes and Persians.

21 And the male goat is a king of the Greeks; and the great horn between its eyes is the first king himself.

22 And the four horns which were shattered and came up behind it, four kings of his nation shall arise, not according to his strength.

23 And at the end of their kingdom, when their sins are being fulfilled, a king shameless in face, understanding riddles, shall arise.

24 And his strength shall be established, and not by his strength, and he shall destroy wonderfully and prosper and act and destroy rulers and a people of holy ones.

25 And his thought is against the holy ones, and falsehood shall prosper in his hands, and his heart shall be exalted, and by deceit he shall make many disappear, and he shall stand for destructions of men and make a gathering of a hand and sell himself.

26 The vision of evening and morning was found to be true; and now the vision is closed up, for it is yet for many days.

27 I, Daniel, became weak for many days, and rising, was again conducting royal affairs. And I was fainting over the vision, and there was no one understanding.

Chapter 9

1 In the first year under Dareios of Xerxes, from the Median race, who reigned over the kingdom of the Chaldeans,

2 in the first year of his reign I, Daniel, considered in the books the number of the years, when an ordinance came to the land concerning Ieremias the prophet, to raise up for the completion of the reproach of Ierusalem, seventy years.

3 And I set my face toward the Lord God to find prayer and mercy with fasts and sackcloth and ashes.

4 And I prayed to the Lord God and confessed and said, Behold, Lord, you are the great and strong and fearful God, keeping the covenant and mercy for those loving you and those keeping your ordinances;

5 we sinned, acted unjustly, acted ungodly and departed and transgressed your commandments and your judgments,

6 and did not hear your servants the prophets, the things they spoke in your name to our kings and our rulers and our fathers and every nation upon the earth.

7 To you, Lord, belongs righteousness, and to us shame of face as on this day, to men of Iouda and those seated in Ierusalem and all the people Israel, the nearest and the farther away, in all the countries into which you scattered them there in the offense with which they offended before you.

8 Master, to us belongs shame of face, and to our kings and rulers and our fathers, because we sinned against you.

9 To the Lord belong righteousness and mercy, because we departed from you,

10 and did not hear the voice of the Lord our God to follow your law which you gave before Moses and us through your servants the prophets.

11 And all Israel abandoned your law and departed so as not to hear your voice, and the curse and the oath written in the law of Moses, servant of God, came upon us, because we sinned against him.

12 And he established for us his ordinances, as much as he spoke against us and against our judges, as much as you judged for us, to bring great evils upon us, such as did not occur under heaven as occurred in Ierusalem.

13 According to what is written in the covenant of Moses, all the evils came upon us, and we did not seek out the face of the Lord our God, to depart from our sins and understand your righteousness, Lord.

14 And the Lord God kept watch over the evils and brought them upon us, because the Lord our God is righteous in everything he may do, and we did not hear his voice.

15 And now, Master, Lord our God, who brought your people out of Egypt with your high arm and made a name for yourself as on this day, we sinned, we have acted in ignorance.

16 Master, according to your righteousness let your wrath and your anger turn away from your city Ierusalem, your holy mountain, because in our sins and in the ignorances of our fathers, Ierusalem and your people, Lord, are a reproach among all those around us.

17 And now hear, Master, the prayer of your servant and attend to my petitions, and let your face look upon your desolate holy mountain for the sake of your servants, Master.

18 Incline your ear, Lord, and hear me; open your eyes and see our desolation and that of your city upon which your name has been called; for it is not on account of our righteous deeds that we petition in our prayers before you, but because of your mercy,

19 Lord, be propitious yourself. Lord, hear and act and do not delay for your own sake, Master, because your name has been called upon your city Sion and upon your people Israel. –

20 And while I was speaking, praying and confessing my sins and the sins of my people Israel and petitioning in prayers before the Lord my God and also for the holy mountain of our God,

21 and while I was still speaking in my prayer, and behold, the man whom I saw in my sleep at the beginning, Gabriel, moving swiftly, approached me at the hour of the evening sacrifice.

22 And he approached and spoke with me and said, Daniel, I have now come out to show you understanding.

23 At the beginning of your petition an ordinance went out from the Lord, and I came to show you, because you are deserving of pity; and understand the ordinance.

24 Seventy weeks were determined for your people and for the city Sion, for sin to be completed and injustices to become scarce and injustices to be wiped away and the vision to be understood and everlasting righteousness to be given and the vision to be completed and a holy of holies to be gladdened.

25 And you shall know and understand and rejoice and find ordinances to be answered, and you shall build Ierusalem as a city for the Lord.

26 And after seven and seventy and sixty-two, an anointing shall be removed and shall not exist, and a kingdom of nations shall destroy the city and the holy place together with the anointed one, and his completion shall come with anger and until a season of completion; from war it shall be warred against.

27 And the covenant shall prevail over many, and again it shall return and be rebuilt in breadth and length; and at the completion of seasons and after seven and seventy seasons and sixty-two years until a season of completion of war, the desolation shall also be removed when the covenant prevails over many weeks; and at the end of the week the sacrifice and the libation shall be taken away, and upon the temple shall be an abomination of desolations until completion, and a completion shall be given upon the desolation.

Chapter 10

1 In the first year of Cyrus king of the Persians, an ordinance was shown to Daniel, whose name was called Baltasar, and the vision and the ordinance are true, and the strong multitude shall understand the ordinance, and I understood it in a vision.

2 In those days I, Daniel, was mourning for three weeks;

3 I did not eat bread of desires, and meat and wine did not enter my mouth; I did not anoint myself with oil until I completed the three weeks of days.

4 And it happened on the twenty-fourth day of the first month, and I was upon the bank of the great river, which is Tigris,

5 and I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, one man clothed in fine linen and girded at the waist with fine linen, and light from his midst,

6 and his body like tharsis, and his face like an appearance of lightning, and his eyes like torches of fire, and his arms and feet like flashing bronze, and the sound of his speech like the sound of a tumult.

7 And I, Daniel, saw this great vision, and the men with me did not see this vision, and strong fear fell upon them, and they fled in haste;

8 and I was left alone and saw this great vision, and no strength was left in me, and behold, a spirit turned upon me for destruction, and I did not prevail.

9 And I did not hear the sound of his speech; I had fallen upon my face upon the earth.

10 And behold, he brought a hand to me and raised me upon my knees, upon the footprints of my feet.

11 And he said to me, Daniel, you are a man deserving of pity; understand the ordinances which I speak to you, and stand upon your place, for I have now been sent to you. And when he spoke this ordinance with me, I stood trembling.

12 And he said to me, Do not fear, Daniel; for from the first day when you set your face to understand and humble yourself before the Lord your God, your word was heard, and I entered [at] your word.

13 And the general of the king of the Persians had stood opposed before me for twenty-one days, and behold, Michael, one of the first rulers, came to help me, and I left him there with the general of the king of the Persians.

14 And he said to me, I came to show you what shall meet your people at the end of the days, for there is yet a vision for days.

15 And when he spoke these ordinances with me, I put my face upon the earth and was silent.

16 And behold, something like a likeness of a man's hand touched my lips; and I opened my mouth and spoke and said to the one standing opposite me, Lord, and like a vision it turned to my side upon me, and there was no strength in me;

17 and how shall the servant be able to speak with his lord? And I became weak, and there is no strength in me, and no spirit was left in me.

18 And one like an appearance of a man again touched me and strengthened me,

19 and said to me, You are a man deserving of pity; do not fear, be well; be courageous and strong. And when he spoke with me, I became strong and said, Let my lord speak, because he strengthened me.

20 And he said to me, Do you know why I came to you? And now I will return to fight with the general of the king of the Persians; and I was going out, and behold, a general of the Greeks was entering.

21 And indeed I will show you the first things in a record of truth, and there was no one helping with me concerning these things except Michael the angel;

Chapter 11

1 And in the first year of King Cyrus he told me to become strong and courageous. –

2 And now I came to show you the truth. Behold, three kings have stood opposed in Persia, and the fourth shall be rich with great wealth beyond all; and when he grows strong in his wealth, he shall rise against every king of the Greeks.

3 And a powerful king shall stand and rule with much dominion and do as he wishes.

4 And when he arises, his kingdom shall be shattered and divided toward the four winds of heaven, not according to his might or according to his dominion with which he ruled, because his kingdom shall be removed, and he shall teach these things to others.

5 And he shall strengthen a kingdom of Egypt; and one of the rulers shall overpower him and rule; his dominion is a great dominion.

6 And he shall bring them to a completion of years, and a king of Egypt shall enter the northern kingdom to make agreements; and he shall certainly not prevail, because his arm shall not establish strength, and his arm shall become numb, and that of those going with him, and he shall remain for hours.

7 And a plant shall arise from his root by itself, and a king of the north shall come against his force in his strength and make a disturbance and prevail.

8 And he shall overthrow their gods with their cast images, and their crowds with the vessels of their desires, silver and gold, they shall carry away in captivity into Egypt; and there shall be a year for a king of the north.

9 And he shall enter the kingdom of Egypt for days; and he shall return to his land,

10 and his son. And he shall be provoked and gather an assembly of a great crowd and enter against it, sweeping along; he shall pass through and return and be greatly incited.

11 And a king of Egypt shall become angry and war with a king of the north, and the assembly shall be delivered into his hands;

12 and he shall take the assembly, and his heart shall be exalted, and he shall disturb many and shall certainly not fear.

13 And a king of the north shall return and gather an assembly of a city greater than the first at the completion of a season of a year, and enter into it against him with a great crowd and with much money.

14 And in those seasons thoughts shall arise against the king of Egypt; and he shall rebuild the fallen things of your nation and arise to establish the prophecy, and they shall stumble.

15 And a king of the north shall come and turn his spears and take the fortified city, and the arms of a king of Egypt shall stand with his rulers, and he shall have no strength to oppose him.

16 And the one coming against him shall do according to his will, and there shall be no one standing opposed before him; and he shall stand in the country, and everything shall be accomplished in his hands.

17 And he shall set his face to come forcibly with all his work, and make agreements with him; and he shall give him a daughter of man to destroy her, and she shall not obey, and it shall not be.

18 And he shall set his face toward the sea and take many, and turn back the anger of their reproach with an oath according to his reproach.

19 He shall turn his face to strengthen his country, and stumble and fall and not be found.

20 And from his root a plant of a kingdom shall arise to stand, a man striking the glory of a king; and in the last days he shall be shattered, and not in anger or in war.

21 And one readily despised shall arise in his place, and glory of a king shall not be given to him; and he shall come suddenly, a king shall prevail in his inheritance.

22 And he shall shatter the shattered arms from before his face;

23 and with the covenant and a people arrayed with him he shall practice falsehood, also against a strong nation with a small nation.

24 Suddenly he shall desolate a city and do what his fathers did not do, nor his fathers' fathers; he shall give them plunder and spoils and money, and devise against the strong city, and his thoughts are in vain.

25 And his strength and his heart shall be roused against the king of Egypt with a great crowd, and the king of Egypt shall be provoked to war with an exceedingly very strong crowd; and he shall not stand, because he shall devise against him with a thought;

26 and his cares shall consume him and turn him back, and he shall pass through and sweep along, and many wounded ones shall fall.

27 And two kings alone shall dine together and eat at one table and speak lies and shall not prosper; for completion is yet for a season.

28 And he shall return to his country with much money, and his heart is against the covenant of the holy place; he shall act and return to his country

29 for a season. And he shall enter Egypt, and it shall not be as the first and the last.

30 And Romans shall come and thrust him out and rebuke him; and he shall return and become angry against the covenant of the holy place; and he shall act and return and devise against them, because they abandoned the covenant of the holy place.

31 And arms from him shall stand and defile the holy place of fear and remove the sacrifice and place an abomination of desolation.

32 And in sins of a covenant they shall defile among a harsh people, and the people knowing these things shall prevail and act.

33 And thoughtful ones of the nation shall bring understanding to many; and they shall stumble by a sword and grow old in it, and be stained in captivity and in plunder of days.

34 And when they are shattered, they shall gather a little strength, and many shall gather to them upon a city, and many as in an inheritance.

35 And some of those understanding shall consider purifying themselves and being chosen and being cleansed until a season of completion; for there is yet a season for hours.

36 And the king shall do according to his will and be provoked to anger and exalted over every god, and shall speak extraordinary things against the God of gods and prosper until the anger is completed; for a completion is coming upon him.

37 And he shall certainly not regard the gods of his fathers and shall certainly not regard a woman's desire, because he shall be exalted in everything, and strong nations shall be subjected to him;

38 in his place he shall also move a god whom his fathers did not know; he shall honor him with gold and silver and precious stone. And with desirable things

39 he shall act concerning cities, and come into a strong fortress; with a foreign god whom he recognizes, he shall multiply glory and rule over him greatly and divide a country as a gift.

40 And at an hour of completion the king of Egypt shall lock horns with him, and a king of the north shall become enraged against him with chariots and many horses and many ships, and enter the country of Egypt,

41 and come into my country,

42 and in the country of Egypt there shall be no one escaping in it.

43 And he shall gain possession of the place of gold and the place of silver and everything desired of Egypt, and Libyans and Ethiopians shall be in his crowd.

44 And a report shall disturb him from the east and north, and he shall go out in strong wrath and with a sword to make many disappear and kill them.

45 And then he shall set his tent between the seas and the mountain of the will of the Holy One; and the hour of his completion shall come, and there shall be no one helping him.

Chapter 12

1 And at that hour Michael, the great angel standing over the sons of your people, shall pass by; that is a day of affliction such as did not occur from when they came into being until that day; and on that day all the people found inscribed in the book shall be exalted.

2 And many of those sleeping in the breadth of the earth shall arise, some to everlasting life, some to reproach, and some to dispersion and everlasting shame.

3 And those understanding shall shine like luminaries of heaven, and those strengthening my words like the stars of heaven forever and ever.

4 And you, Daniel, cover the ordinances and seal the book until a season of completion, until the many go mad and the earth is filled with injustice. –

5 And I, Daniel, saw, and behold, two others stood, one on this side of the river and one on that side.

6 And I said to the one clothed in fine linen above, When then is the completion of the wonders you have told me, and their purification?

7 And I heard the one clothed in fine linen who was above the water of the river, Until a season of completion; and he raised his right and left hands to heaven and swore by God who lives forever, that for a season and seasons and half a season is the completion of hands of release of a holy people, and all these things shall be completed.

8 And I heard and did not understand at that very time, and said, Lord, what is the resolution of this word, and of what are these parables?

9 And he said to me, Go away, Daniel, because the ordinances are covered and sealed, until

10 many are tested and sanctified, and sinners sin; and all the sinners shall certainly not understand, and those understanding shall pay attention.

11 From when the continual sacrifice is removed and the abomination of desolation is prepared to be placed, a thousand two hundred ninety days.

12 Blessed is the one remaining, and he shall reach a thousand three hundred thirty-five days.

13 And you, go, rest; for there are yet days and hours for the fulfillment of completion, and you shall rest and arise to your glory at the completion of days.

2 Daniel

Chapter 1

1 In the third year of the reign of Ioakim king of Iouda, Nabouchodonosor king of Babylon came to Ierusalem and was besieging it.

2 And the Lord gave into his hand Ioakim king of Iouda and some of the vessels of the house of God, and he brought them to the land of Sennaar, to the house of his god; and he brought the vessels into the treasury house of his god.

3 And the king told Asphanez his chief eunuch to bring in from the sons of the captivity of Israel and from the seed of the kingdom and from the phorthommin,

4 young men in whom there is no blemish, and beautiful in appearance and understanding in all wisdom and knowing knowledge and comprehending prudence, and in whom there is strength to stand in the king's house, and to teach them letters and the language of the Chaldeans.

5 And the king appointed for them the daily portion each day from the king's table and from the wine of his drinking, and to nourish them for three years, and after these things to stand before the king.

6 And among them, from the sons of Iouda, were Daniel and Ananias and Misael and Azarias.

7 And the chief eunuch put names upon them, upon Daniel, Baltasar, and upon Ananias, Sedrach, and upon Misael, Misach, and upon Azarias, Abdenago.

8 And Daniel set upon his heart that he should certainly not be polluted with the king's table and with the wine of his drinking, and petitioned the chief eunuch that he should certainly not be polluted.

9 And God gave Daniel mercy and compassion before the chief eunuch.

10 And the chief eunuch said to Daniel, I fear my lord the king, who appointed your food and your drink, lest he see your faces gloomy beside the boys of your age, and you condemn my head before the king.

11 And Daniel said to Amelsad, whom the chief eunuch appointed over Daniel, Ananias, Misael, Azarias,

12 Test your servants now for ten days, and let them give us some of the seeds, and we shall eat and drink water;

13 and let our appearances be seen before you, and the appearances of the boys eating the king's table, and as you see, deal with your servants.

14 And he listened to them and tested them for ten days.

15 And after the end of the ten days their appearances were seen to be good and strong in flesh beyond the boys eating the king's table.

16 And Amelsad was taking away their dinner and the wine of their drink, and was giving them seeds.

17 And these boys, the four of them, God gave them understanding and prudence in all literature and wisdom; and Daniel understood in every vision and dreams.

18 And after the end of the days when the king said to bring them in, the chief eunuch also brought them before Nabouchodonosor.

19 And the king spoke with them, and from all of them none was found like Daniel and Ananias and Misael and Azarias; and they stood before the king.

20 And in every matter of wisdom and knowledge which the king sought from them, he found them tenfold beyond all the enchanters and magi in all his kingdom.

21 And Daniel continued until the first year of King Cyrus.

Chapter 2

1 In the second year of the reign of Nabouchodonosor, Nabouchodonosor dreamed a dream, and his spirit was beside itself, and his sleep departed from him.

2 And the king said to call the enchanters and the magi and the sorcerers and the Chaldeans to tell the king his dreams, and they came and stood before the king.

3 And the king said to them, I dreamed, and my spirit was beside itself to know the dream.

4 And the Chaldeans spoke to the king in Syrian, King, live forever; you tell the dream to your servants, and we shall announce the interpretation.

5 The king answered and said to the Chaldeans, The word has departed from me; if you do not make known to me the dream and its interpretation, you shall be for destruction, and your houses shall be plundered;

6 but if you make known to me the dream and its interpretation, you shall receive gifts and presents and much honor from me; only tell me the dream and its interpretation.

7 They answered a second time and said, Let the king tell the dream to his servants, and we shall announce its interpretation.

8 The king answered and said, Truly I know that you are buying time, because you saw that the matter departed from me;

9 therefore if you do not tell me the dream, I know that you agreed to say a false and corrupt word before me until the season passes; tell me my dream, and I shall know that you shall tell me its interpretation.

10 The Chaldeans answered before the king and say, There is no man upon dry land who shall be able to make known the king's matter, because no great king and ruler asks such a matter of an enchanter, magus and Chaldean;

11 for the word which the king asks is difficult, and there is no other who shall announce it before the king except gods, whose dwelling is not with any flesh.

12 Then the king, in wrath and much anger, said to destroy all the wise men of Babylon;

13 and the decree went out, and the wise men were being killed, and they sought Daniel and his friends to kill them.

14 Then Daniel answered with counsel and opinion to Arioch, the king's chief cook, who went out to kill the wise men of Babylon:

15 Officer of the king, concerning what did the shameless decision go out from the presence of the king? And Arioch made the matter known to Daniel.

16 And Daniel entered and petitioned the king to give him time, and that he might announce its interpretation to the king.

17 And Daniel entered his house and made the matter known to Ananias and Misael and Azarias, his friends;

18 and they were seeking compassion from the God of heaven concerning this mystery, so that Daniel and his friends might not perish with the remaining wise men of Babylon.

19 Then the mystery was revealed to Daniel in a vision of the night; and he blessed the God of heaven,

20 Daniel, and said, May the name of God be blessed from everlasting and to everlasting, because wisdom and understanding are his;

21 and he changes seasons and times, appoints kings and removes them, giving wisdom to the wise and prudence to those knowing understanding;

22 he reveals deep and hidden things, knowing the things in darkness, and the light is with him;

23 to you, the God of my fathers, I give thanks and praise, because you gave me wisdom and power and now made known to me what we petitioned from you, and made known to me the king's vision.

24 And Daniel came to Arioch, whom the king appointed to destroy the wise men of Babylon, and said to him, Do not destroy the wise men of Babylon, but bring me before the king, and I will tell the interpretation to the king.

25 Then Arioch hastily brought Daniel before the king and said to him, I have found a man from the sons of the captivity of Ioudaia who shall announce the interpretation to the king.

26 And the king answered and said to Daniel, whose name was Baltasar, Are you able to tell me the dream which I saw and its interpretation?

27 And Daniel answered before the king and says, The mystery which the king asks is not for wise men, magi, enchanters, Gazarenes to announce to the king,

28 but there is a God in heaven revealing mysteries, and he made known to King Nabouchodonosor what must happen at the end of the days. Your dream and the visions of your head upon your bed are these.

29 You, king, your thoughts upon your bed came up, what must happen after these things, and the one revealing mysteries made known to you what must happen.

30 And to me this mystery was not revealed by wisdom existing in me beyond all the living, but for the sake of making the interpretation known to the king, so that you may know the thoughts of your heart.

31 You, king, were watching, and behold, one image; that image was great and its appearance surpassing, standing before your face, and its sight fearful;

32 the image, whose head was of fine gold, its hands and chest and arms silver, the belly and the thighs bronze,

33 the shins iron, the feet partly iron and partly earthenware.

34 You were watching until a stone was cut from a mountain without hands and struck the image upon the iron and earthenware feet and reduced them to fineness completely.

35 Then the earthenware, the iron, the bronze, the silver, the gold were reduced to fineness at once and became like dust from a summer threshing floor; and the abundance of wind carried them away, and no place was found for them; and the stone which struck the image became a great mountain and filled all the earth.

36 This is the dream; and we shall tell its interpretation before the king.

37 You, king, are a king of kings, to whom the God of heaven gave a strong and mighty and honored kingdom;

38 in every place where the sons of men dwell, both beasts of the field and birds of heaven he gave into your hand, and appointed you lord of all; you are the golden head.

39 And after you another kingdom inferior to you shall arise, and a third kingdom which is the bronze, which shall rule over all the earth.

40 And a fourth kingdom shall be strong like iron; in the manner that iron reduces to fineness and subdues everything, so it shall reduce everything to fineness and subdue it.

41 And because you saw the feet and the toes partly earthenware and partly iron, it shall be a divided kingdom, and some of the iron root shall be in it, in the manner that you saw the iron mixed with the earthenware;

42 and the toes of the feet partly iron and partly earthenware, some part of the kingdom shall be strong, and some of it shall be shattered.

43 Because you saw the iron mixed with the earthenware, they shall be mingled in the seed of men and shall not cling one to another, as iron does not mix with earthenware.

44 And in the days of those kings the God of heaven shall raise up a kingdom which shall not be destroyed forever, and his kingdom shall not be left to another people; it shall reduce to fineness and winnow all the kingdoms, and it shall itself arise forever,

45 in the manner that you saw that a stone was cut from a mountain without hands and reduced to fineness the earthenware, the iron, the bronze, the silver, the gold. The great God made known to the king what must happen after these things, and the dream is true, and its interpretation trustworthy.

46 Then King Nabouchodonosor fell upon his face and worshiped Daniel, and said to pour out a manaa and fragrances for him.

47 And answering, the king said to Daniel, Truly your God himself is God of gods and Lord of kings and a revealer of mysteries, because you were able to reveal this mystery.

48 And the king exalted Daniel and gave him great and many gifts, and appointed him over the whole country of Babylon and ruler of satraps over all the wise men of Babylon.

49 And Daniel requested from the king, and he appointed Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago over the works of the country of Babylon; and Daniel was in the king's court.

Chapter 3

1 In the eighteenth year Nabouchodonosor the king made a golden image, its height sixty cubits, its breadth six cubits, and set it up in the plain of Deira in the country of Babylon.

2 And he sent to gather the consuls and the generals and the local governors, leaders and tyrants and those in authority and all the rulers of the countries, to come to the dedication of the image which Nabouchodonosor the king had set up;

3 and the local governors, consuls, generals, leaders, great tyrants, those in authority and all the rulers of the countries gathered for the dedication of the image which Nabouchodonosor the king had set up, and stood before the image which Nabouchodonosor had set up.

4 And the herald cried with strength: To you it is said, peoples, tribes, tongues:

5 at whatever hour you hear the sound of the trumpet and pipe and lyre, sambyke and psaltery and symphony and every kind of musical instrument, fall down and worship the golden image which Nabouchodonosor the king has set up;

6 and whoever does not fall down and worship shall at that very hour be thrown into the burning furnace of fire.

7 And it happened, when the peoples heard the sound of the trumpet and pipe and lyre, sambyke and psaltery and symphony and every kind of musical instrument, all the peoples, tribes, tongues fell down and worshipped the golden image which Nabouchodonosor the king had set up.

8 Then Chaldean men approached and accused the Jews

9 before King Nabouchodonosor: King, live unto the ages;

10 you, king, established a decree that every person who hears the sound of the trumpet and pipe and lyre, sambyke and psaltery and symphony and every kind of musical instrument

11 and does not fall down and worship the golden image shall be thrown into the burning furnace of fire;

12 there are Jewish men whom you appointed over the affairs of the country of Babylon, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago. Those men have not obeyed your decree, king; they do not serve your gods and do not worship the golden image which you set up.

13 Then Nabouchodonosor in wrath and anger said to bring Sedrach, Misach and Abdenago, and they were brought before the king.

14 And Nabouchodonosor answered and said to them: Is it truly so, Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, that you do not serve my gods and do not worship the golden image which I set up?

15 Now therefore, if you are ready, so that whenever you hear the sound of the trumpet and pipe and lyre, sambyke and psaltery and symphony and every kind of musical instrument, you fall down and worship the image which I made; but if you do not worship, at that very hour you shall be thrown into the burning furnace of fire; and who is the god who will deliver you from my hands?

16 And Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago answered, saying to King Nabouchodonosor: We have no need to answer you concerning this matter;

17 for there is a God whom we serve, able to deliver us from the burning furnace of fire, and from your hands, king, he will rescue us;

18 and if not, let it be known to you, king, that we do not serve your gods and do not worship the golden image which you set up.

19 Then Nabouchodonosor was filled with wrath, and the appearance of his face was changed against Sedrach, Misach and Abdenago, and he said to heat the furnace sevenfold, until it was completely heated;

20 and he told men mighty in strength to bind Sedrach, Misach and Abdenago and throw them into the burning furnace of fire.

21 Then those men were bound with their trousers and tiaras and greaves and their garments, and were thrown into the midst of the burning furnace of fire.

22 Since the king's word prevailed, and the furnace was heated exceedingly.

23 And these three, Sedrach, Misach and Abdenago, fell into the midst of the burning furnace of fire, bound.

24 And they walked in the midst of the flame, hymning God and blessing the Lord.

25 And Azarias stood up and prayed thus, and opened his mouth in the midst of the fire and said:

26 Blessed are you, Lord, the God of our fathers, and praiseworthy, and your name is glorified unto the ages,

27 because you are righteous in all that you have done to us, and all your works are true, and your ways straight, and all your judgments truth,

28 and you made judgments of truth in all that you brought upon us and upon the holy city of our fathers, Ierusalem, because in truth and judgment you brought all these things upon us because of our sins.

29 Because we sinned and acted lawlessly in departing from you, and we sinned in all things and did not listen to your commandments

30 nor keep them nor do as you commanded us, that it might be well with us.

31 And all that you brought upon us, and all that you did to us, you did in true judgment

32 and handed us over into the hands of lawless enemies, most hateful apostates, and to a king unjust and most wicked beyond all the earth.

33 And now it is not possible for us to open our mouth; shame and reproach have come upon your servants and those who revere you.

34 Do not indeed hand us over completely, for your name's sake, and do not scatter your covenant

35 and do not remove your mercy from us, for the sake of Abraam, loved by you, and for the sake of Isaak your servant and Israel your holy one,

36 to whom you spoke, saying to them that you would multiply their seed as the stars of heaven and as the sand beside the shore of the sea.

37 Because, Master, we have been diminished beyond all the nations, and we are lowly in all the earth today because of our sins,

38 and at this time there is no ruler and prophet and leader, nor whole burnt offering nor sacrifice nor offering nor incense, no place to make a fruit offering before you and find mercy;

39 but with a broken soul and a spirit of humiliation may we be accepted, as with whole burnt offerings of rams and bulls and as with myriads of fat lambs;

40 thus let our sacrifice be before you today, and to accomplish it behind you, because there shall be no shame for those who trust in you.

41 And now we follow with our whole heart and fear you and seek your face; do not put us to shame,

42 but do with us according to your forbearance and according to the multitude of your mercy

43 and deliver us according to your wonders and give glory to your name, Lord.

44 And may all who display evils toward your servants be ashamed, and may they be put to shame away from all power and dominion, and may their strength be broken;

45 let them know that you alone are the Lord God and glorious over the whole inhabited world.

46 And the king's attendants who had thrown them in did not cease heating the furnace with naphtha and pitch and tow and vine branches.

47 And the flame spread above the furnace to forty-nine cubits

48 and passed through and burned those of the Chaldeans whom it found around the furnace.

49 But the angel of the Lord descended together with those around Azarias into the furnace and shook the flame of fire out of the furnace

50 and made the midst of the furnace like a whistling wind of dew, and the fire did not touch them at all and did not hurt or trouble them.

51 Then the three, as from one mouth, hymned and glorified and blessed God in the furnace, saying:

52 Blessed are you, Lord, the God of our fathers, and praiseworthy and highly exalted unto the ages, and blessed is the holy name of your glory, and exceedingly praiseworthy and highly exalted unto the ages.

53 Blessed are you in the temple of your holy glory, and exceedingly hymned and exceedingly glorious unto the ages.

55 Blessed are you, who look upon abysses, seated upon cheroubin, and praiseworthy and highly exalted unto the ages.

54 Blessed are you upon the throne of your kingdom, and exceedingly hymned and highly exalted unto the ages.

56 Blessed are you in the firmament of heaven, and hymned and glorified unto the ages.

57 Bless the Lord, all the works of the Lord; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

59 Bless the Lord, heavens; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

58 Bless the Lord, angels of the Lord; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

60 Bless the Lord, all waters above heaven; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

61 Bless the Lord, all the powers; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

62 Bless the Lord, sun and moon; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

63 Bless the Lord, stars of heaven; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

64 Bless the Lord, all rain and dew; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

65 Bless the Lord, all the winds; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

66 Bless the Lord, fire and heat; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

67 Bless the Lord, cold and scorching heat; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

68 Bless the Lord, dews and snowstorms; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

71 Bless the Lord, nights and days; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

72 Bless the Lord, light and darkness; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

69 Bless the Lord, ice and cold; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

70 Bless the Lord, frosts and snows; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

73 Bless the Lord, lightnings and clouds; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

74 Let the earth bless the Lord; let it hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

75 Bless the Lord, mountains and hills; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

76 Bless the Lord, all things growing in the earth; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

78 Bless the Lord, seas and rivers; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

77 Bless the Lord, springs; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

79 Bless the Lord, sea creatures and all things moving in the waters; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

80 Bless the Lord, all the birds of heaven; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

81 Bless the Lord, all the beasts and livestock; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

82 Bless the Lord, sons of men; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

83 Bless the Lord, Israel; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

84 Bless the Lord, priests of the Lord; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

85 Bless the Lord, servants of the Lord; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

86 Bless the Lord, spirits and souls of the righteous; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

87 Bless the Lord, holy ones and humble in heart; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages.

88 Bless the Lord, Ananias, Azarias, Misael; hymn and highly exalt him unto the ages, because he delivered us from Hades and saved us from the hand of death and rescued us from the midst of a furnace of burning flame, and from the midst of fire he rescued us.

89 Give thanks to the Lord, because he is good, because his mercy is unto the age.

90 Bless, all who revere the Lord, the God of gods; hymn and give thanks, because his mercy is unto the age.

91 And Nabouchodonosor heard them hymning and wondered and rose up in haste and said to his magnates: Did we not throw three men bound into the midst of the fire? And they said to the king: Truly, king.

92 And the king said: Behold, I see four men loosed and walking in the midst of the fire, and there is no destruction in them, and the appearance of the fourth is like a son of God.

93 Then Nabouchodonosor approached the door of the burning furnace of fire and said: Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, servants of the Most High God, come out and come here. And Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago came out from the midst of the fire.

94 And the satraps and the generals and the local governors and the king's potentates gather, and they observed the men, that the fire had not ruled their body, and the hair of their head had not been set aflame, and their trousers had not been changed, and there was no smell of fire on them.

95 And Nabouchodonosor answered and said: Blessed is the God of Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago, who sent his angel and delivered his servants, because they trusted in him and changed the king's word and handed over their bodies to fire, so that they might not serve or worship any god except their God;

96 and I set forth a decree: Every people, tribe, tongue that speaks blasphemy against the God of Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago shall be for destruction, and their houses for plunder, because there is no other god who shall be able to rescue thus.

97 Then the king directed Sedrach, Misach, Abdenago in the country of Babylon and deemed them worthy to lead all the Jews who were in his kingdom.

Chapter 4

1 Nabouchodonosor the king to all the peoples, tribes and tongues dwelling in all the earth: May peace be multiplied to you;

2 the signs and wonders which the Most High God did with me, it pleased me to announce to you

3 how great and mighty they are; his kingdom is an eternal kingdom, and his authority unto generation and generation.

4 I, Nabouchodonosor, was prospering in my house and flourishing.

5 I saw a dream, and it frightened me, and I was troubled upon my bed, and the visions of my head disturbed me.

6 And through me a decree was established to bring before me all the wise men of Babylon, that they might make known to me the interpretation of the dream.

7 And the enchanters, magicians, Gazarenes, Chaldeans came in, and I told the dream before them, and they did not make its interpretation known to me,

8 until Daniel came, whose name is Baltasar according to the name of my god, who has a holy spirit of God in himself, and I told the dream before him:

9 Baltasar, ruler of the enchanters, whom I knew, that a holy spirit of God is in you and no mystery is beyond your ability, hear the vision of the dream which I saw, and tell me its interpretation.

10 Upon my bed I was observing, and behold, a tree in the midst of the earth, and its height great.

11 The tree grew great and strong, and its height reached heaven and its bulk the ends of all the earth;

12 its leaves beautiful, and its fruit abundant, and food for all in it; and beneath it the wild beasts encamped, and in its branches the birds of heaven dwelt, and all flesh was fed from it.

13 I was observing in a vision of the night upon my bed, and behold, an ir and holy one descended from heaven

14 and called with strength and said thus: Cut down the tree and pluck off its branches and shake off its leaves and scatter its fruit; let the beasts be moved from beneath it and the birds from its branches;

15 only leave the growth of its roots in the earth, and in a bond of iron and bronze and in the grass outside, and in the dew of heaven he shall lie, and with the beasts his portion shall be in the grass of the earth.

16 His heart shall be changed from that of humans, and a beast's heart shall be given to him, and seven times shall pass over him.

17 By a decision of ir is the word, and the demand a saying of holy ones, that the living may know that the Most High is lord of the kingdom of humans, and to whomever he pleases he will give it, and the despised among humans he will raise over it.

18 This is the dream which I, Nabouchodonosor the king, saw; and you, Baltasar, tell the interpretation, because all the wise men of my kingdom cannot show me its interpretation, but you, Daniel, can, because a holy spirit of God is in you.

19 Then Daniel, whose name is Baltasar, was stunned for about one hour, and his thoughts disturbed him. And the king answered and said: Baltasar, let the dream and the interpretation not alarm you. And Baltasar answered and said: Lord, may the dream be for those who hate you, and its interpretation for your enemies.

20 The tree which you saw, which grew great and strong, whose height reached heaven and its bulk all the earth,

21 and its leaves flourishing and its fruit abundant and food for all in it, beneath which the wild beasts dwelt and in whose branches the birds of heaven encamped,

22 is you, king, because you grew great and strong, and your greatness grew and reached heaven and your dominion the ends of the earth.

23 And because the king saw an ir and holy one descending from heaven, and he said: Pluck off the tree and destroy it, only leave the growth of its roots in the earth, and in a bond of iron and bronze and in the grass outside, and in the dew of heaven he shall lodge, and with wild beasts his portion shall be, until seven times pass over him,

24 this is its interpretation, king, and it is a decision of the Most High which has reached my lord the king,

25 and they shall drive you out from humans, and your dwelling shall be with wild beasts, and they shall feed you grass like an ox, and you shall lodge in the dew of heaven, and seven times shall pass over you, until you know that the Most High rules the kingdom of humans, and to whomever he pleases he will give it.

26 And because they said: Leave the growth of the tree's roots, your kingdom shall remain for you from the time you know the heavenly authority.

27 Therefore, king, let my counsel please you, and redeem your sins with almsgiving and your injustices with compassion for the poor; perhaps God will be patient with your transgressions. –

28 All these things reached Nabouchodonosor the king.

29 After twelve months, walking upon the palace of his kingdom in Babylon,

30 the king answered and said: Is this not Babylon the great, which I built for a house of kingship by the might of my strength, for the honor of my glory?

31 While the word was still in the king's mouth, a voice came from heaven: To you they say, King Nabouchodonosor: The kingdom has passed from you,

32 and they shall drive you out from humans, and your dwelling shall be with wild beasts, and they shall feed you grass like an ox, and seven times shall pass over you, until you know that the Most High rules the kingdom of humans, and to whomever he pleases he will give it.

33 At that very hour the word was accomplished upon Nabouchodonosor, and he was driven out from humans and ate grass like an ox, and his body was drenched by the dew of heaven, until his hair grew like lions' and his nails like birds'.

34 And after the end of the days I, Nabouchodonosor, lifted my eyes to heaven, and my understanding returned to me, and I blessed the Most High and praised and glorified him who lives unto the age, because his authority is eternal authority and his kingdom unto generation and generation,

35 and all who dwell on the earth were reckoned as nothing, and he does according to his will in the power of heaven and in the dwelling of the earth, and there is none who will oppose his hand and say to him: What have you done?

36 At that very time my understanding returned to me, and I came into the honor of my kingdom, and my form returned to me, and my tyrants and my magnates sought me, and I was strengthened over my kingdom, and greater greatness was added to me.

37 Now therefore I, Nabouchodonosor, praise and highly exalt and glorify the King of heaven, because all his works are true and his paths judgment, and all who walk in arrogance he is able to humble.

Chapter 5

1 Baltasar the king made a great dinner for his thousand magnates, and before the thousand was the wine. And drinking,

2 Baltasar said, at the taste of the wine, to bring the golden and silver vessels which Nabouchodonosor his father had taken out of the temple in Ierusalem, and let the king and his magnates and his concubines and his wives drink in them.

3 And the golden and silver vessels which he had taken out of the temple of God in Ierusalem were brought, and the king and his magnates and his concubines and his wives drank in them;

4 they drank wine and praised the golden and silver and bronze and iron and wooden and stone gods.

5 At that very hour fingers of a human hand came out and wrote opposite the lamp upon the plaster of the wall of the king's house, and the king observed the joints of the hand that was writing.

6 Then the king's form was changed, and his thoughts disturbed him, and the joints of his loins were loosened, and his knees knocked together.

7 And the king cried with strength to bring in magicians, Chaldeans, Gazarenes, and said to the wise men of Babylon: Whoever reads this writing and makes its interpretation known to me shall be clothed in purple, and the golden necklace shall be upon his neck, and he shall rule third in my kingdom.

8 And all the king's wise men came in and could not read the writing nor make its interpretation known to the king.

9 And King Baltasar was greatly troubled, and his form was changed upon him, and his magnates were disturbed.

10 And the queen entered the drinking house and said: King, live unto the ages; let your thoughts not trouble you, and let your form not be changed;

11 there is a man in your kingdom in whom is a spirit of God, and in the days of your father wakefulness and understanding were found in him, and King Nabouchodonosor your father appointed him ruler of enchanters, magicians, Chaldeans, Gazarenes,

12 because an extraordinary spirit is in him, and prudence and understanding, interpreting dreams and announcing concealed things and loosing bonds, Daniel, and the king put upon him the name Baltasar; now therefore let him be called, and he will announce its interpretation to you.

13 Then Daniel was brought before the king, and the king said to Daniel: Are you Daniel, of the sons of the captivity of Ioudaia which the king my father brought?

14 I heard about you that a spirit of God is in you, and wakefulness and understanding and extraordinary wisdom were found in you.

15 And now the wise men, magicians, Gazarenes came before me, that they might read this writing and make its interpretation known to me, and they could not announce it to me.

16 And I heard about you that you can interpret judgments; now therefore if you can read the writing and make its interpretation known to me, you shall be clothed in purple, and the golden necklace shall be upon your neck, and you shall rule third in my kingdom.

17 Then Daniel answered and said before the king: Let your gifts be yours, and give the gift of your house to another; but I shall read the writing to the king and make its interpretation known to you.

18 King, the Most High God gave the kingdom and greatness and honor and glory to Nabouchodonosor your father,

19 and because of the greatness which he gave him, all the peoples, tribes, tongues trembled and feared before him; whom he wished, he killed, and whom he wished, he struck, and whom he wished, he exalted, and whom he wished, he humbled.

20 And when his heart was exalted and his spirit grew strong to act arrogantly, he was brought down from the throne of his kingdom, and his honor was taken away from him,

21 and he was driven out from humans, and his heart was given with the beasts, and his dwelling was with wild asses, and they fed him grass like an ox, and his body was drenched by the dew of heaven, until he knew that the Most High God rules the kingdom of humans, and to whomever he pleases he will give it.

22 And you, his son Baltasar, did not humble your heart before him, although you knew all these things,

23 and you exalted yourself against the Lord God of heaven, and they brought the vessels of his house before you, and you and your magnates and your concubines and your wives drank wine in them, and you praised the golden and silver and bronze and iron and wooden and stone gods, which do not see and do not hear and do not know, and the God in whose hand is your breath and all your ways, him you did not glorify.

24 Therefore from before him a joint of a hand was sent, and it inscribed this writing.

25 And this is the writing inscribed: Mane thekel phares.

26 This is the interpretation of the saying: mane, God measured your kingdom and completed it;

27 thekel, it was weighed in a balance and found deficient;

28 phares, your kingdom has been divided and given to Medes and Persians.

29 And Baltasar spoke, and they clothed Daniel in purple and put the golden necklace around his neck, and he proclaimed concerning him that he should be third ruler in the kingdom.

30 On that very night Baltasar the king of the Chaldeans was killed.

Chapter 6

1 And Dareios the Mede received the kingdom, being sixty-two years old.

2 And it pleased Dareios, and he appointed over the kingdom a hundred and twenty satraps to be in his whole kingdom,

3 and above them three administrators, of whom Daniel was one, for the satraps to render account to them, so that the king might not be troubled;

4 and Daniel was above them, because an extraordinary spirit was in him, and the king appointed him over his whole kingdom.

5 And the administrators and the satraps sought to find a pretext against Daniel; and they found no pretext or transgression or fault against him, because he was faithful.

6 And the administrators said: We shall not find a pretext against Daniel except in the ordinances of his God.

7 Then the administrators and the satraps stood before the king and said to him: King Dareios, live unto the ages;

8 all the generals and satraps, consuls and local governors over your kingdom have taken counsel to establish by a royal enactment and strengthen a restriction, that whoever asks a request from any god or human for thirty days except from you, king, shall be thrown into the pit of lions;

9 now therefore, king, establish the restriction and issue a writing, so that the decree of Medes and Persians may not be changed.

10 Then King Dareios commanded the decree to be written.

11 And Daniel, when he knew that the decree had been inscribed, entered his house, and his windows were open in his upper rooms opposite Ierusalem, and three times a day he bent upon his knees and prayed and gave thanks before his God, as he had been doing before.

12 Then those men watched and found Daniel making request and supplicating his God.

13 And approaching, they say to the king: King, did you not establish a restriction, that every person who asks a request from any god or human for thirty days except from you, king, shall be thrown into the pit of lions? And the king said: The word is true, and the decree of Medes and Persians shall not pass away.

14 Then they answered and say before the king: Daniel, of the sons of the captivity of Ioudaia, has not submitted to your decree concerning the restriction which you established, and three times a day he asks his requests from his God.

15 Then the king, when he heard the saying, was greatly grieved at it and struggled concerning Daniel to deliver him, and until evening he was struggling to deliver him.

16 Then those men say to the king: Know, king, that it is a decree for Medes and Persians that no restriction and enactment which the king establishes must be altered.

17 Then the king spoke, and they brought Daniel and threw him into the pit of lions; and the king said to Daniel: Your God, whom you serve continually, he will deliver you.

18 And they brought a stone and placed it upon the mouth of the pit, and the king sealed it with his ring and with the ring of his magnates, so that nothing might be changed concerning Daniel.

19 And the king went away to his house and lay down without dinner, and they did not bring foods to him, and sleep departed from him. And God shut the mouths of the lions, and they did not trouble Daniel.

20 Then the king rose early in the light and came in haste to the pit of lions;

21 and as he drew near the pit he cried with a strong voice: Daniel, servant of the living God, has your God, whom you serve continually, been able to deliver you from the mouth of the lions?

22 And Daniel said to the king: King, live unto the ages;

23 my God sent his angel and blocked the mouths of the lions, and they did not injure me, because uprightness was found in me before him; and also before you, king, I did no transgression.

24 Then the king was greatly gladdened at it and said to bring Daniel up from the pit; and Daniel was brought up from the pit, and no destruction was found in him, because he believed in his God.

25 And the king spoke, and they brought the men who had accused Daniel, and they were thrown into the pit of lions, they and their sons and their wives; and they had not reached the floor of the pit before the lions ruled over them and crushed all their bones.

26 Then Dareios the king wrote to all the peoples, tribes, tongues dwelling in all the earth: May peace be multiplied to you;

27 from before me a decree was established, that in every domain of my kingdom they should tremble and fear before the God of Daniel, because he is the living God and remains unto the ages, and his kingdom shall not be destroyed, and his dominion is unto the end;

28 he takes hold and rescues and does signs and wonders in heaven and upon the earth, he who delivered Daniel from the hand of the lions.

29 And Daniel prospered in the kingdom of Dareios and in the kingdom of Cyrus the Persian.

Chapter 7

1 In the first year of Baltasar king of the Chaldeans, Daniel saw a dream, and the visions of his head upon his bed, and he wrote the dream:

2 I, Daniel, was observing in my vision of the night, and behold, the four winds of heaven struck against the great sea.

3 And four great beasts came up from the sea, differing from one another.

4 The first was like a lioness, and its wings like an eagle's; I was observing until its wings were plucked out, and it was lifted from the earth and stood upon human feet, and a human heart was given to it.

5 And behold, a second beast like a bear, and it stood upon one side, and three ribs were in its mouth between its teeth, and thus they said to it: Rise, eat much flesh.

6 After this I was observing, and behold, another beast like a leopard, and it had four bird's wings above it, and the beast had four heads, and authority was given to it.

7 After this I was observing, and behold, a fourth beast, fearful and terrifying and exceedingly strong, and its teeth great and iron, eating and crushing, and it trampled the remainder with its feet, and it differed exceedingly from all the beasts before it, and it had ten horns.

8 I considered its horns, and behold, another small horn came up in their midst, and three of the horns before it were uprooted before it, and behold, eyes like human eyes were in this horn, and a mouth speaking great things.

9 I was observing until thrones were placed, and an ancient of days sat, and his garment was white like snow, and the hair of his head like clean wool; his throne a flame of fire, its wheels burning fire;

10 a river of fire flowed before him, a thousand thousands ministered to him, and ten thousand myriads stood before him; a court sat, and books were opened.

11 I was observing then because of the sound of the great words which that horn spoke, until the beast was killed and perished, and its body was given to burning by fire.

12 And the rule of the remaining beasts was removed, and length of life was given to them until a time and a time.

13 I was observing in a vision of the night, and behold, with the clouds of heaven one like a son of man was coming, and he reached the ancient of days and was brought before him.

14 And to him were given rule and honor and the kingdom, and all the peoples, tribes, tongues shall serve him; his authority is eternal authority, which shall not pass away, and his kingdom shall not be destroyed. –

15 My spirit shuddered within my condition, I, Daniel, and the visions of my head troubled me.

16 And I approached one of those standing and sought from him the exact truth concerning all these things, and he told me the exact truth and made known to me the interpretation of the words:

17 These four great beasts, four kingdoms shall arise upon the earth, which shall be taken away;

18 and holy ones of the Most High shall receive the kingdom and hold it unto the age of the ages.

19 And I sought precisely concerning the fourth beast, because it differed from every beast, exceedingly fearful, its teeth iron and its claws bronze, eating and crushing, and it trampled the remainder with its feet,

20 and concerning its ten horns upon its head and the other which came up and shook out three of the earlier ones, that horn which had eyes and a mouth speaking great things, and its appearance greater than the remaining ones.

21 I was observing, and that horn made war with the holy ones and prevailed against them,

22 until the ancient of days came and gave judgment to holy ones of the Most High, and the time arrived and the holy ones possessed the kingdom.

23 And he said: The fourth beast shall be a fourth kingdom in the earth, which shall surpass all the kingdoms and devour all the earth and trample it and cut it down.

24 And its ten horns, ten kings shall arise, and after them another shall arise, who shall surpass in evils all those before him, and shall humble three kings;

25 and he shall speak words against the Most High and wear out the holy ones of the Most High and intend to change times and law, and it shall be given into his hand until a time and times and half a time.

26 And the court shall sit, and they shall remove the rule to annihilate and destroy unto the end.

27 And the kingdom and authority and greatness of the kings beneath all heaven were given to holy ones of the Most High, and his kingdom is an eternal kingdom, and all the rulers shall serve and obey him.

28 Thus far is the end of the word. I, Daniel, my thoughts greatly disturbed me, and my form was changed upon me, and I kept the saying in my heart.

Chapter 8

1 In the third year of the kingdom of Baltasar the king a vision appeared to me, I, Daniel, after the one which appeared to me at the beginning.

2 And I was in Sousa the citadel, which is in the country of Ailam, and I saw in a vision, and I was upon the Oubal,

3 and I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, one ram standing before the Oubal, and it had horns, and the horns were high, and the one higher than the other, and the high one came up last.

4 I saw the ram butting toward the sea and north and south, and none of the beasts shall stand before it, and there was none delivering from its hand, and it did according to its will and grew great.

5 And I was considering, and behold, a male goat came from the southwest over the face of all the earth and was not touching the earth, and the goat had a conspicuous horn between its eyes.

6 And it came to the ram which had the horns, which I had seen standing before the Oubal, and ran toward it in the impulse of its strength.

7 And I saw it reach the ram, and it became fierce against it and struck the ram and broke both its horns, and the ram had no strength to stand before it; and it threw it upon the earth and trampled it, and there was none delivering the ram from its hand.

8 And the male goat grew exceedingly great, and when it became strong its great horn was broken, and four horns came up beneath it toward the four winds of heaven.

9 And from one of them came out one strong horn, and it grew exceedingly great toward the south and toward the east and toward the host;

10 it grew great unto the host of heaven, and fell upon the earth from the host of heaven and from the stars, and trampled them,

11 and until the chief commander rescues the captivity, and because of it sacrifice was dashed down, and it happened and prospered for it, and the sanctuary shall be desolated;

12 and sin was given against the sacrifice, and righteousness was thrown to the ground, and it acted and prospered.

13 And I heard one holy one speaking, and one holy one said to the phelmouni who was speaking: Until when shall the vision stand, the sacrifice taken away and the sin of desolation given, and the sanctuary and the host be trampled?

14 And he said to him: Until evening and morning, two thousand and three hundred days, and the sanctuary shall be cleansed.

15 And it happened, when I, Daniel, saw the vision and sought understanding, and behold, there stood before me something like the appearance of a man.

16 And I heard a man's voice between the Oubal, and it called and said: Gabriel, cause that one to understand the vision.

17 And he came and stood beside where I stood, and when he came I was terrified and fall upon my face, and he said to me: Understand, son of man, for the vision is still for the end of a time.

18 And when he spoke with me I fall upon my face upon the earth, and he touched me and stood me upon my feet

19 and said: Behold, I make known to you the things which shall be at the last of the wrath; for the vision is still for the end of a time.

20 The ram which you saw, which has the horns, is king of Medes and Persians.

21 And the male goat is king of Greeks; and the great horn which was between its eyes, it is the first king.

22 And of the broken one, beneath which four horns stood, four kings shall arise from his nation, and not in his strength.

23 And at the last of their kingdom, when their sins are being fulfilled, a king shameless in face and understanding riddles shall arise.

24 And his strength shall be mighty, and not in his own strength, and he shall destroy wondrously and prosper and act and destroy mighty ones and a holy people.

25 And the yoke of his collar shall prosper; deceit is in his hand, and he shall grow great in his heart and destroy many by deceit and stand for the destruction of many and break them like eggs with a hand.

26 And the vision of the evening and the morning which was spoken is true; and you, seal the vision, because it is for many days.

27 And I, Daniel, lay down and was sick for days, and rose and did the king's affairs; and I wondered at the vision, and there was none understanding.

Chapter 9

1 In the first year of Dareios the son of Asoueros, of the seed of the Medes, who reigned over the kingdom of the Chaldeans,

2 in year one of his kingdom I, Daniel, understood in the books the number of the years concerning which the word of the Lord came to Ieremias the prophet for the completion of the desolation of Ierusalem, seventy years.

3 And I gave my face toward the Lord God to seek prayer and supplications with fastings and sackcloth and ashes.

4 And I prayed to the Lord my God and confessed and said: Lord, the great and wonderful God, who keeps your covenant and mercy for those who love you and those who keep your commandments,

5 we sinned, acted unjustly, acted lawlessly and departed and turned aside from your commandments and from your judgments

6 and did not listen to your servants the prophets, who spoke in your name to our kings and our rulers and our fathers and to all the people of the land.

7 To you, Lord, belongs righteousness, and to us shame of face as this day, to the man of Iouda and those dwelling in Ierusalem and all Israel, those near and those far in all the earth, where you scattered them there in their unfaithfulness with which they were unfaithful to you.

8 Lord, to us belongs shame of face, and to our kings and our rulers and our fathers, we who sinned against you.

9 To the Lord our God belong compassions and propitiations, because we departed

10 and did not listen to the voice of the Lord our God, to walk in his laws which he gave before us by the hands of his servants the prophets.

11 And all Israel transgressed your law and turned aside so as not to hear your voice, and the curse and the oath written in the law of Moyses the servant of God came upon us, because we sinned against him.

12 And he established his words which he spoke against us and against our judges who judged us, to bring great evils upon us, such as have not happened beneath all heaven according to what happened in Ierusalem.

13 As it is written in the law of Moyses, all these evils came upon us, and we did not supplicate the face of the Lord our God, to turn from our injustices and to understand in all your truth.

14 And the Lord watched and brought them upon us, because the Lord our God is righteous in all his doing which he did, and we did not listen to his voice.

15 And now, Lord our God, who brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand and made yourself a name as this day, we sinned, we acted lawlessly.

16 Lord, in all your mercy let your wrath and your anger indeed turn away from your city Ierusalem, your holy mountain, because we sinned, and through our injustices and those of our fathers Ierusalem and your people became a reproach among all those around us.

17 And now hear, Lord our God, the prayer of your servant and his supplications, and make your face shine upon your desolate sanctuary for your sake, Lord.

18 Incline your ear, my God, and hear; open your eyes and see our annihilation and that of your city upon which your name has been called; because it is not on our righteous acts that we cast our plea for compassion before you, but on your many compassions.

19 Lord, hear; Lord, be propitious; Lord, attend and act; do not delay, for your sake, my God, because your name has been called upon your city and upon your people. –

20 And while I was still speaking and praying and confessing my sins and the sins of my people Israel and casting my plea for mercy before the Lord my God concerning the holy mountain of my God,

21 and while I was still speaking in prayer, and behold, the man Gabriel, whom I saw in the vision at the beginning, flying, touched me about the hour of the evening sacrifice.

22 And he caused me to understand and spoke with me and said: Daniel, now I came out to instruct you in understanding.

23 At the beginning of your supplication a word came out, and I came to announce it to you, because you are a man of desires; and consider the saying and understand the apparition.

24 Seventy weeks were cut short upon your people and upon your holy city, for sin to be completed and to seal sins and wipe away lawless acts and to make atonement for injustices and to bring eternal righteousness and to seal vision and prophet and to anoint a holy of holies.

25 And you shall know and understand: from the going out of a word to answer and to build Ierusalem until an anointed leader, seven weeks and sixty-two weeks; and it shall return, and street and wall shall be built, and the times shall be emptied out.

26 And after the sixty-two weeks an anointing shall be utterly destroyed, and there is no judgment in it; and he shall destroy the city and the sanctuary together with the leader who comes, and they shall be cut off in a flood, and until the end of a shortened war he shall appoint desolations.

27 And he shall strengthen a covenant for many, one week; and in the half of the week my sacrifice and libation shall be taken away, and upon the temple an abomination of desolations, and until the completion of a time a completion shall be given upon the desolation.

Chapter 10

1 In the third year of Cyrus king of the Persians a word was revealed to Daniel, whose name was called Baltasar, and the word was true, and great power and understanding were given to him in the apparition.

2 In those days I, Daniel, was mourning three weeks of days;

3 bread of desires I did not eat, and meat and wine did not enter my mouth, and I did not anoint myself with ointment until the completion of three weeks of days.

4 On the twenty-fourth day of the first month, and I was beside the great river, it is Eddekel,

5 and I lifted my eyes and saw, and behold, one man clothed in baddin, and his loins girded with gold of Ophaz,

6 and his body like tharsis, and his face like the appearance of lightning, and his eyes like torches of fire, and his arms and legs like the appearance of gleaming bronze, and the sound of his words like the sound of a crowd.

7 And I, Daniel, alone saw the apparition, and the men with me did not see the apparition, but a great astonishment fell upon them, and they fled in fear;

8 and I was left alone and saw this great apparition, and no strength was left in me, and my glory was changed into destruction, and I retained no strength.

9 And I heard the sound of his words, and when I heard him I was stunned, and my face was upon the earth.

10 And behold, a hand touching me, and it raised me upon my knees.

11 And he said to me: Daniel, man of desires, understand the words which I speak to you, and stand in your position, because now I was sent to you. And when he spoke this word to me I rose trembling.

12 And he said to me: Do not fear, Daniel; because from the first day on which you gave your heart to understand and to be afflicted before your God, your words were heard, and I came because of your words.

13 And the ruler of the kingdom of the Persians stood opposite me twenty-one days, and behold, Michael, one of the first rulers, came to help me, and I left him there with the ruler of the kingdom of the Persians

14 and came to cause you to understand all that shall meet your people at the last of the days, because the vision is still for days.

15 And when he spoke with me according to these words I gave my face to the earth and was stunned.

16 And behold, something like the likeness of a son of man touched my lips; and I opened my mouth and spoke and said to the one standing before me: Lord, in your apparition my inward parts were turned within me, and I had no strength;

17 and how shall your servant, lord, be able to speak with this my lord? And as for me, from now no strength shall stand in me, and no breath was left in me.

18 And again one like the appearance of a human touched me and strengthened me

19 and said to me: Do not fear, man of desires, peace to you; be courageous and be strong. And when he spoke with me I became strong and said: Let my lord speak, because you strengthened me.

20 And he said: Do you know why I came to you? And now I shall return to war with the ruler of the Persians; and I was going out, and the ruler of the Greeks was coming.

21 But I shall announce to you what is inscribed in a writing of truth, and there is not one holding with me concerning these things except Michael your ruler;

Chapter 11

1 And I, in the first year of Cyrus, stood for might and strength. –

2 And now I shall announce truth to you. Behold, three kings shall yet arise in Persia, and the fourth shall be rich with great wealth beyond all; and after becoming strong through his wealth he shall rise against all the kingdoms of Greeks.

3 And a mighty king shall arise and rule a great dominion and do according to his will.

4 And as soon as he stands, his kingdom shall be broken and divided toward the four winds of heaven, and not to his descendants nor according to his dominion which he ruled, because his kingdom shall be plucked out and given to others besides these.

5 And the king of the south shall become strong; and one of his rulers shall become strong against him and rule a great dominion over his authority.

6 And after his years they shall mingle, and a daughter of the king of the south shall come to the king of the north to make agreements with him; and she shall not retain strength of arm, and his seed shall not stand, and she shall be handed over, and those bringing her and the young woman and the one strengthening her in the times.

7 And from the blossom of her root one shall stand in his position and come to the host and enter the strongholds of the king of the north and act in them and prevail.

8 And indeed their gods with their molten images, every desirable vessel of theirs of silver and gold, he shall carry with captivity into Egypt; and he shall stand above the king of the north.

9 And he shall enter the kingdom of the king of the south; and return to his land.

10 And his sons shall gather a multitude of many forces, and he shall come, coming and flooding; and he shall pass through and settle down and engage in combat as far as his stronghold.

11 And the king of the south shall become fierce and go out and war with the king of the north; and he shall establish a great multitude, and the multitude shall be handed over into his hand;

12 and he shall take the multitude, and his heart shall be exalted, and he shall cast down myriads and shall not prevail.

13 And the king of the north shall return and bring a multitude greater than the earlier one, and at the end of the times of years he shall come on with an advance in great force and with much substance.

14 And in those times many shall rise against the king of the south; and the sons of the pestilent ones of your people shall be lifted up to establish a vision and shall grow weak.

15 And the king of the north shall come and pour out a mound and seize fortified cities, and the arms of the king of the south shall not stand, and his chosen ones shall arise, and there shall be no strength to stand.

16 And the one coming against him shall do according to his will, and there is none standing before him; and he shall stand in the land of sabi, and it shall be completed in his hand.

17 And he shall set his face to come with the strength of his whole kingdom, and he shall make all things straight with him; and he shall give him a daughter of women to destroy her, and she shall certainly not remain and shall not be for him.

18 And he shall turn his face toward the islands and seize many and stop rulers of their reproach, only his reproach shall return to him.

19 And he shall turn his face toward the stronghold of his land and grow weak and fall and not be found.

20 And from his root a plant of kingship shall arise in his position, causing to pass through, exacting the glory of a kingdom; and in those days he shall be broken, and not in faces nor in war.

21 He shall stand in his position; he was despised, and they did not give him the glory of a kingdom; and he shall come in prosperity and prevail over kingdoms through slippery dealings.

22 And the arms of the one flooding shall be flooded from before him and broken, and a leader of a covenant;

23 and from the minglings with him he shall practice deceit and go up and overpower him with a small nation.

24 And in prosperity and in fertile countries he shall come and do what his fathers and his fathers' fathers did not do; booty and spoils and substance he shall scatter to them, and against Egypt he shall devise his devices, even until a time.

25 And his strength and his heart shall be stirred against the king of the south with a great force, and the king of the south shall join battle with a great and exceedingly strong force; and he shall not stand, because they shall devise devices against him;

26 and they shall eat his necessary provisions and break him, and he shall flood forces, and many wounded shall fall.

27 And both kings, their hearts are toward wickedness, and at one table they shall speak falsehoods, and it shall not prosper; because the end is still for a time.

28 And he shall return to his land with much substance, and his heart shall be against a holy covenant, and he shall act and return to his land.

29 At the time he shall return and come into the south, and it shall not be as the first and as the last.

30 And the Kitian ones going out shall come against him, and he shall be humbled; and he shall return and be enraged against a holy covenant; and he shall act and return and give heed to those forsaking a holy covenant.

31 And seeds from him shall arise and profane the sanctuary of dominion and remove the continual offering and give an abomination made desolate.

32 And those acting lawlessly against a covenant shall bring on through slippery dealings, and a people knowing their God shall prevail and act.

33 And the understanding ones of the people shall understand many things; and they shall grow weak by sword and by flame and by captivity and by plundering for days.

34 And when they grow weak they shall be helped with a little help, and many shall be added to them through slippery dealings.

35 And some of those understanding shall grow weak, to refine them and to select and to reveal, until the end of a time; because it is still for a time.

36 And he shall do according to his will, and the king shall be exalted and grow great above every god and speak excessive things and prosper, until the wrath is completed; for it happens toward completion.

37 And he shall not give heed to all the gods of his fathers, nor to the desire of women, and he shall not give heed to any god, because he shall grow great above all;

38 and he shall glorify a god maozin in his place, and a god whom his fathers did not know he shall glorify with gold and silver and precious stone and desirable things.

39 And he shall act for the fortifications of refuges with a foreign god and multiply glory and subject many to them and divide land in gifts.

40 And at the end of a time he shall clash with the king of the south, and the king of the north shall gather against him with chariots and horsemen and many ships, and enter the land and break and pass through.

41 And he shall enter the land of sabi, and many shall grow weak; and these shall be saved from his hand, Edom and Moab and the chief part of the sons of Ammon.

42 And he shall stretch his hand over the land, and the land of Egypt shall not be for salvation.

43 And he shall rule over the hidden stores of gold and silver and over all the desirable things of Egypt and of Libyans and Ethiopians in their fortifications.

44 And reports and urgent messages shall trouble him from the east and from the north, and he shall come in great wrath to annihilate and to devote many to destruction.

45 And he shall pitch his tent ephadano between the seas, toward a holy mountain sabi; and he shall come to his portion, and there is none rescuing him.

Chapter 12

1 And at that time Michael shall arise, the great ruler who stands over the sons of your people; and there shall be a time of affliction, an affliction such as has not happened since a nation came into being upon the earth until that time; and at that time your people shall be saved, everyone found written in the book.

2 And many of those sleeping in the earth's mound shall be awakened, these to eternal life and these to reproach and to eternal shame.

3 And those understanding shall shine out like the brightness of the firmament, and some of the many righteous like the stars unto the ages and still further.

4 And you, Daniel, shut up the words and seal the book until a time of completion, until many are taught and knowledge is multiplied. –

5 And I, Daniel, saw, and behold, two others stood, one on this side of the bank of the river and one on that side of the bank of the river.

6 And he said to the man clothed in the baddin, who was above the water of the river: Until when is the end of the wonders which you have spoken?

7 And I heard the man clothed in the baddin, who was above the water of the river, and he lifted his right hand and his left hand to heaven and swore by him who lives unto the age: For a time of times and half a time; when the scattering of the hand of a sanctified people is completed, they shall know all these things.

8 And I heard and did not understand and said: Lord, what are the last things of these?

9 And he said: Come, Daniel, because the words are shut up and sealed until the end of a time;

10 may many be selected and made white and refined, and may lawless ones act lawlessly; and all lawless ones shall not understand, and the intelligent shall understand.

11 And from the time of the alteration of the continual offering and the giving of an abomination of desolation, a thousand two hundred and ninety days.

12 Blessed is the one enduring and reaching a thousand three hundred and thirty-five days.

13 And you, come and rest; for there are still days toward the fulfillment of completion, and you shall rise to your lot at the completion of days.

1 Bel and the Dragon

Chapter 1

1 From the prophecy of Ambakoum son of Iesous, of the tribe of Levi.

2 There was a certain man, a priest, whose name was Daniel son of Abal, a companion of the king of Babylon.

3 And there was an idol, Bel, which the Babylonians revered; and twelve artabas of fine flour and four sheep and six measures of oil were expended for it each day.

4 And the king revered it, and the king went each day and worshipped it; but Daniel prayed to the Lord.

5 And the king said to Daniel: Why do you not worship Bel? And Daniel said to the king: I revere no one except the Lord God, who created heaven and earth and has dominion over all flesh.

6 And the king said to him: Is this, then, not a god? Do you not see how much is spent on it each day?

7 And Daniel said to him: By no means; let no one deceive you; for this is clay within and bronze without; and I swear to you by the Lord, the God of gods, that this has never eaten anything.

8 And the king, enraged, called those presiding over the temple and said to them: Show the one eating what is prepared for Bel; but if not, you shall die, or Daniel who asserts that these things are not eaten by it. And they said: Bel himself is the one devouring them.

9 And Daniel said to the king: Let it be thus; if I do not show that Bel is not the one devouring these things, I shall die, and all those with me. And there were seventy priests for Bel, apart from women and children.

10 And they brought the king into the idol's shrine.

11 And the foods were set before the king and Daniel, and mixed wine was brought in and set before Bel. And Daniel said: You yourself see that these things are laid here, king; therefore you seal the locks of the temple when it is closed.

13 And the word pleased the king.

14 And Daniel commanded his people, after putting everyone out of the temple, to sprinkle the whole temple with ashes, with none outside him knowing. And then he commanded the temple to be sealed with the king's ring and the rings of certain distinguished priests; and it happened thus.

15-17 And it happened on the next day that they arrived at the place; and the priests of Bel had entered through concealed doors and devoured everything laid beside Bel and drunk up the wine. And Daniel said: Look upon your seals, whether they remain, men who are priests; and you also, king, consider whether anything inconsistent has happened for you. And they found the seal as it had been, and removed the seal.

18 And opening the doors, they saw everything set out consumed and the tables empty; and the king rejoiced and said to Daniel: Bel is great, and there is no deceit with him.

19 And Daniel laughed exceedingly and said to the king: Come, see the deceit of the priests. And Daniel said: King, whose are these footprints?

20 And the king said: Of men and women and children.

21 And he went to the house in which the priests were staying and found the foods of Bel and the wine; and Daniel showed the king the concealed doors through which the priests entered and consumed what was set before Bel.

22 And the king brought them out of the shrine of Bel and handed them over to Daniel; and he gave Daniel the expenditure for it, and overthrew Bel.

23 And there was a dragon in the same place, and the Babylonians revered it.

24 And the king said to Daniel: Surely you will not also say that this is bronze? Behold, it lives and eats and drinks; worship it.

25 And Daniel said: King, give me the authority, and I shall kill the dragon without iron and staff.

26 And the king granted it to him and said to him: It is given to you.

27 And Daniel took thirty minas of pitch and fat and hairs, boiled them together and made a cake and threw it into the dragon's mouth, and after eating it burst apart. And he showed it to the king, saying: Do you not revere these things, king?

28 And all those from the country gathered against Daniel and said: The king has become a Jew; he overthrew Bel and killed the dragon.

30 And the king, seeing that the crowd of the country had gathered against him, called his companions and said: I give Daniel for destruction.

31-32 And there was a pit in which seven lions were fed, to which those plotting against the king were handed over, and each day two bodies of those condemned to death were supplied to them. And the crowds threw Daniel into that pit, so that he might be devoured and not even obtain burial. And Daniel was in the pit six days.

33 And it happened on the sixth day, and Ambakoum had breads crumbled in a bowl in a boiled dish and a jar of mixed wine, and was going into the plain to the reapers.

34 And an angel of the Lord spoke to Ambakoum, saying: Thus says the Lord God to you: The meal which you have, take away to Daniel in the pit of lions in Babylon.

35 And Ambakoum said: Lord God, I have not seen Babylon, and I do not know where the pit is.

36 And the angel of the Lord took hold of him, Ambakoum, by the hair of his head and placed him above the pit in Babylon.

37 And Ambakoum said to Daniel: Rise and eat the meal which the Lord God sent you.

38 And Daniel said: For the Lord God has remembered me, he who does not forsake those who love him.

39 And Daniel ate; and the angel of the Lord set Ambakoum where he had taken him from, on the same day. And the Lord God remembered Daniel.

40 And after these things the king came out mourning Daniel and, bending into the pit, sees him sitting.

41 And the king cried out and said: Great is the Lord God, and there is no other except him.

42 And the king brought Daniel out of the pit; and those responsible for his destruction he threw into the pit before Daniel, and they were devoured.

2 Bel and the Dragon

Chapter 1

1 And King Astyages was added to his fathers, and Cyrus the Persian received his kingdom.

2 And Daniel was a companion of the king and distinguished beyond all his friends.

3 And the Babylonians had an idol whose name was Bel, and twelve artabas of fine flour and forty sheep and six measures of wine were expended for it each day.

4 And the king revered it and went each day to worship it; but Daniel worshipped his God.

5 And the king said to him: Why do you not worship Bel? And he said: Because I do not revere idols made by hands, but the living God who created heaven and earth and has dominion over all flesh.

6 And the king said to him: Does Bel not seem to you to be a living god? Indeed, do you not see how much he eats and drinks each day?

7 And Daniel laughed and said: Do not be deceived, king; for this is clay within and bronze without, and has never eaten or drunk.

8 And the king, enraged, called its priests and said to them: If you do not tell me who is devouring this expenditure, you shall die; but if you show that Bel devours them, Daniel shall die, because he blasphemed against Bel.

9 And Daniel said to the king: Let it be according to your saying. And there were seventy priests of Bel, apart from women and children.

10 And the king came with Daniel into the house of Bel.

11 And the priests of Bel said: Behold, we run off outside, but you, king, set out the foods and mix the wine and set it out and shut the door and seal it with your ring; and when you come early, if you do not find everything eaten by Bel, we shall die, or Daniel who lies against us.

12 And they were scornful, because they had made a hidden entrance beneath the table and continually entered through it and consumed them.

13 And it happened when those men went out, and the king set the foods before Bel.

14 And Daniel commanded his boys, and they brought ashes and sprinkled the whole temple before the king alone; and going out they closed the door and sealed it with the king's ring, and departed.

15 And the priests came at night according to their custom, and their wives and their children, and devoured everything and drank it up.

16 And the king rose early in the morning, and Daniel with him.

17 And the king said: Are the seals safe, Daniel? And he said: Safe, king.

18 And it happened, as soon as the doors were opened, the king looked upon the table and cried with a great voice: Great are you, Bel, and there is not even one deceit with you.

19 And Daniel laughed and restrained the king from entering inside and said: Look indeed at the floor and know whose these footprints are.

20 And the king said: I see the footprints of men and women and children.

21 And the king, angered, then seized the priests and their wives and their children, and they showed him the hidden doors through which they entered and consumed the things upon the table.

22 And the king killed them and gave Bel over to Daniel, and he overthrew it and its temple.

23 And there was a great dragon, and the Babylonians revered it.

24 And the king said to Daniel: You cannot say that this is not a living god; and worship it.

25 And Daniel said: I shall worship the Lord my God, because he is a living God; but you, king, give me authority, and I shall kill the dragon without sword and staff.

26 And the king said: I give it to you.

27 And Daniel took pitch and fat and hairs and boiled them together and made cakes and put them into the dragon's mouth, and the dragon ate and burst apart. And he said: See your objects of reverence.

28 And it happened when the Babylonians heard, they were exceedingly indignant and banded together against the king and said: The king has become a Jew; he pulled down Bel and killed the dragon and slaughtered the priests.

29 And coming to the king they said: Hand Daniel over to us; but if not, we shall kill you and your house.

30 And the king saw that they pressed him exceedingly, and being compelled he handed Daniel over to them.

31 And they threw him into the pit of lions, and he was there six days.

32 And there were seven lions in the pit, and two bodies and two sheep were given to them each day; but then none were given to them, so that they might devour Daniel.

33 And Ambakoum the prophet was in Ioudaia, and he boiled a boiled dish and crumbled breads into a bowl and was going to the plain to take it to the reapers.

34 And an angel of the Lord said to Ambakoum: Take the meal which you have to Babylon, to Daniel in the pit of lions.

35 And Ambakoum said: Lord, I have not seen Babylon and do not know the pit.

36 And the angel of the Lord took hold of the crown of his head and, carrying him by the hair of his head, placed him in Babylon above the pit in the rushing of his spirit.

37 And Ambakoum cried, saying: Daniel, Daniel, take the meal which God sent you.

38 And Daniel said: For you remembered me, God, and did not forsake those who love you.

39 And Daniel rose and ate; and the angel of God immediately restored Ambakoum to his place.

40 And the king came on the seventh day to mourn Daniel; and he came to the pit and looked in, and behold, Daniel sitting.

41 And crying out with a great voice he said: Great are you, Lord, the God of Daniel, and there is no other except you.

42 And he pulled him up, and those responsible for his destruction he threw into the pit, and they were devoured immediately before him.

Matthew

Chapter 1

1 Book of the origin of Jesus Christ, son of Dabid, son of Abraam.

2 Abraam begot Isaak, and Isaak begot Iakob, and Iakob begot Ioudas and his brothers,

3 and Ioudas begot Phares and Zara from Thamar, and Phares begot Esrom, and Esrom begot Aram,

4 and Aram begot Aminadab, and Aminadab begot Naasson, and Naasson begot Salmon,

5 and Salmon begot Booz from Rachab, and Booz begot Obed from Routh, and Obed begot Iessai,

6 and Iessai begot Dabid the king, and Dabid the king begot Solomon from the woman of Ourias,

7 and Solomon begot Roboam, and Roboam begot Abia, and Abia begot Asa,

8 and Asa begot Iosaphat, and Iosaphat begot Ioram, and Ioram begot Ozias,

9 and Ozias begot Ioatham, and Ioatham begot Achaz, and Achaz begot Ezekias,

10 and Ezekias begot Manasses, and Manasses begot Amon, and Amon begot Iosias,

11 and Iosias begot Iechonias and his brothers at the deportation to Babylon.

12 And after the deportation to Babylon Iechonias begot Salathiel, and Salathiel begot Zorobabel,

13 and Zorobabel begot Abioud, and Abioud begot Eliakeim, and Eliakeim begot Azor,

14 and Azor begot Sadok, and Sadok begot Acheim, and Acheim begot Elioud,

15 and Elioud begot Eleazar, and Eleazar begot Matthan, and Matthan begot Iakob,

16 and Iakob begot Joseph, the husband of Maria, from whom Jesus was born, who is called Christ.

17 Therefore all the generations from Abraam until Dabid are fourteen generations, and from Dabid until the deportation to Babylon fourteen generations, and from the deportation to Babylon until the Christ fourteen generations.

18 And the birth of Jesus Christ was thus: for when his mother Maria was betrothed to Joseph, before they came together, she was found having a child in the womb from the Holy Spirit.

19 And Joseph her husband, being righteous and not wishing to expose her publicly, resolved to release her secretly.

20 And when he considered these things, behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in a dream, saying: Joseph, son of Dabid, do not fear to take Mariam your wife, for what was begotten in her is from the Holy Spirit.

21 And she shall bear a son, and you shall call his name Jesus, for he shall save his people from their sins.

22 And this whole thing has happened so that what was spoken by the Lord through the prophet might be fulfilled, saying:

23 Behold, the virgin shall have a child in the womb and bear a son, and they shall call his name Emmanuel, which translated is: God with us.

24 And Joseph, awakened from sleep, did as the angel of the Lord commanded him and took his wife,

25 and did not know her until she bore her firstborn son, and he called his name Jesus.

Chapter 2

1 And when Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Ioudaia in the days of Herod the king, behold, magi from the east arrived in Hierosolyma,

2 saying: Where is the one born king of the Jews? For we saw his star in the east and came to worship him.

3 And Herod the king, hearing, was troubled, and all Hierosolyma with him,

4 and gathering all the chief priests and scribes of the people, he inquired from them where the Christ is born.

5 And they said to him: In Bethlehem of Ioudaia, for thus it is written through the prophet:

6 And you, Bethlehem, land of Iouda, are by no means least among the rulers of Iouda; for from you shall come out a leader who shall shepherd my people Israel.

7 Then Herod, secretly calling the magi, ascertained precisely from them the time of the star appearing,

8 and sending them to Bethlehem said: Go and inquire precisely concerning the child, and when you find him, announce it to me, so that I also may come and worship him.

9 And hearing the king, they went, and behold, the star which they saw in the east went before them until it came and stood above where the child was.

10 And seeing the star, they rejoiced with exceedingly great joy,

11 and coming into the house they found the child with Maria his mother, and falling down they worshipped him, and opening their treasures they offered him gifts, gold and frankincense and myrrh.

12 And being instructed in a dream not to return to Herod, they withdrew to their country by another way.

13 And when they withdrew, behold, an angel of the Lord appears in a dream to Joseph, saying: Rise, take the child and his mother and flee into Egypt, and be there until I tell you; for Herod is about to seek the child to destroy him.

14 And he rose and took the child and his mother by night and withdrew into Egypt,

15 and was there until the death of Herod, so that what was spoken by the Lord through the prophet might be fulfilled, saying: Out of Egypt I called my son.

16 Then Herod, seeing that he was mocked by the magi, was exceedingly enraged, and sending out he killed all the boys in Bethlehem and in all its boundaries, from two years old and below, according to the time which he had precisely ascertained from the magi.

17 Then what was spoken by Ieremias the prophet was fulfilled, saying:

18 A voice was heard in Rama, lamentation and weeping and much wailing, Rachel weeping for her children, and she did not wish to be comforted, because they are not.

19 And when Herod died, behold, an angel of the Lord appears in a dream to Joseph in Egypt,

20 saying: Rise, take the child and his mother and go into the land of Israel; for those seeking the soul of the child have died.

21 And he rose and took the child and his mother and came into the land of Israel.

22 And hearing that Archelaos reigns over Ioudaia instead of Herod his father, he feared to go there; and being instructed in a dream, he withdrew into the parts of Galilee,

23 and coming, he dwelt in a city called Nazaret, so that what was spoken through the prophets might be fulfilled: He shall be called a Nazorean.

Chapter 3

1 And in those days John the Baptist arrives, proclaiming in the wilderness of Ioudaia

2 and saying: Repent, for the kingdom of the heavens has drawn near.

3 For this is the one spoken of by Esaias the prophet, saying: A voice of one crying in the wilderness: Prepare the way of the Lord, make his paths straight.

4 And John himself had his garment of camel's hairs and a leather belt around his loins, and his food was locusts and wild honey.

5 Then Hierosolyma and all Ioudaia and all the surrounding country of the Jordan went out to him,

6 and were baptized in the Jordan by him, confessing their sins.

7 And seeing many of the Pharisees and Sadducees coming to his baptism, he said to them: Offspring of vipers, who showed you to flee from the coming wrath?

8 Therefore produce fruits worthy of repentance,

9 and do not think to say within yourselves: We have Abraam as father; for I say to you that God can raise up children for Abraam from these stones.

10 And already the axe also lies at the root of the trees; therefore every tree not producing good fruit is cut down and thrown into fire.

11 I indeed baptize you in water for repentance, but the one coming after me is stronger than I, whose sandals I am not sufficient to carry; he shall baptize you in the Holy Spirit and fire,

12 whose winnowing shovel is in his hand, and he shall thoroughly cleanse his threshing floor and gather his grain into the storehouse, but burn up the chaff with unquenchable fire.

13 Then Jesus arrives from Galilee at the Jordan to John, to be baptized by him.

14 But John tried to prevent him, saying: I have need to be baptized by you, and you come to me?

15 And Jesus answered and said to him: Permit it now, for thus it is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness. Then he permits him.

16 And Jesus, baptized, came up immediately from the water, and behold, the heavens were opened to him, and he saw the Spirit of God descending like a dove and coming upon him,

17 and behold, a voice from the heavens, saying: This is my beloved son, in whom I was well pleased.

Chapter 4

1 Then Jesus was led up into the wilderness by the Spirit to be tempted by the devil.

2 And fasting forty days and forty nights, afterward he hungered.

3 And the tempter approached him and said: If you are a son of God, say that these stones become breads.

4 And he answered and said: It is written: A human shall not live on bread alone, but on every saying coming out through the mouth of God.

5 Then the devil takes him to the holy city and sets him upon the pinnacle of the temple,

6 and says to him: If you are a son of God, throw yourself down; for it is written that he shall command his angels concerning you, and upon their hands they shall lift you, lest you strike your foot against a stone.

7 Jesus said to him: Again it is written: You shall not put the Lord your God to the test.

8 Again the devil takes him to an exceedingly high mountain and shows him all the kingdoms of the world and their glory,

9 and says to him: All these things I shall give you, if you fall down and worship me.

10 Then Jesus says to him: Go away, Satan; for it is written: You shall worship the Lord your God and serve him alone.

11 Then the devil leaves him, and behold, angels approached and ministered to him.

12 And Jesus, hearing that John was handed over, withdrew into Galilee,

13 and leaving Nazaret, he came and dwelt in Capernaoum beside the sea, in the boundaries of Zaboulon and Nephthaleim,

14 so that what was spoken through Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, saying:

15 Land of Zaboulon and land of Nephthaleim, way of the sea, beyond the Jordan, Galilee of the nations,

16 the people sitting in darkness saw a great light, and for those sitting in a country and shadow of death, light arose for them.

17 From then Jesus began to proclaim and say: Repent, for the kingdom of the heavens has drawn near.

18 And Jesus, walking beside the sea of Galilee, saw two brothers, Simon who is called Peter and Andrew his brother, throwing a casting net into the sea, for they were fishermen,

19 and says to them: Come after me, and I shall make you fishermen of humans.

20 And immediately leaving the nets, they followed him.

21 And going on from there, he saw two other brothers, Iakobos the son of Zebedaios and John his brother, in the boat with Zebedaios their father, mending their nets, and called them.

22 And immediately leaving the boat and their father, they followed him.

23 And Jesus went around all Galilee, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the good news of the kingdom and healing every disease and every infirmity among the people.

24 And the report of him went into all Syria, and they brought to him all those who were ill, afflicted with various diseases and torments, and those possessed by demons and those moonstruck and paralytics, and he healed them.

25 And many crowds followed him from Galilee and Decapolis and Hierosolyma and Ioudaia and beyond the Jordan.

Chapter 5

1 And seeing the crowds, he went up onto the mountain, and when he sat down his disciples approached him,

2 and opening his mouth he taught them, saying:

3 Blessed are the poor in spirit, because theirs is the kingdom of the heavens.

4 Blessed are those mourning, because they shall be comforted.

5 Blessed are the meek, because they shall inherit the earth.

6 Blessed are those hungering and thirsting for righteousness, because they shall be filled.

7 Blessed are the merciful, because they shall receive mercy.

8 Blessed are the clean in heart, because they shall see God.

9 Blessed are the peacemakers, because they shall be called sons of God.

10 Blessed are those persecuted for righteousness, because theirs is the kingdom of the heavens.

11 Blessed are you when they reproach you and persecute and say every evil saying against you, lying, for my sake.

12 Rejoice and exult, because your reward is great in the heavens; for thus they persecuted the prophets before you.

13 You are the salt of the earth; but if the salt becomes tasteless, with what shall it be salted? It has strength for nothing any longer except to be thrown outside and trampled by humans.

14 You are the light of the world. A city lying above a mountain cannot be hidden,

15 nor do they light a lamp and place it under the bushel measure, but upon the lampstand, and it shines for all in the house.

16 Thus let your light shine before humans, so that they may see your good works and glorify your Father in the heavens.

17 Do not think that I came to dissolve the law or the prophets; I did not come to dissolve but to fulfill.

18 For amen, I say to you: until heaven and earth pass away, one iota or one stroke shall certainly not pass away from the law until everything happens.

19 Therefore whoever loosens one of these least commandments and teaches humans thus shall be called least in the kingdom of the heavens; but whoever does and teaches, this one shall be called great in the kingdom of the heavens.

20 For I say to you that unless your righteousness abounds beyond that of the scribes and Pharisees, you shall certainly not enter the kingdom of the heavens.

21 You heard that it was said to the ancients: You shall not murder; and whoever murders shall be liable to the judgment.

22 But I say to you that everyone angry with his brother without cause shall be liable to the judgment; and whoever says to his brother: Raka, shall be liable to the council; and whoever says: Fool, shall be liable to the Gehenna of fire.

23 Therefore if you offer your gift upon the altar and there remember that your brother has something against you,

24 leave your gift there before the altar and go, first be reconciled to your brother, and then come and offer your gift.

25 Be well disposed to your adversary quickly, while you are on the way with him, lest the adversary hand you over to the judge and the judge hand you over to the attendant and you be thrown into prison.

26 Amen, I say to you: you shall certainly not come out from there until you repay the last quadrans.

27 You heard that it was said to the ancients: You shall not commit adultery.

28 But I say to you that everyone looking at a woman to desire her has already committed adultery with her in his heart.

29 And if your right eye causes you to stumble, take it out and throw it away from you; for it benefits you that one of your members perish and your whole body not be thrown into Gehenna.

30 And if your right hand causes you to stumble, cut it off and throw it away from you; for it benefits you that one of your members perish and your whole body not be thrown into Gehenna.

31 And it was said: Whoever releases his wife, let him give her a document of divorce.

32 But I say to you that whoever releases his wife, except for a matter of fornication, causes her to commit adultery, and whoever marries a released woman commits adultery.

33 Again you heard that it was said to the ancients: You shall not swear falsely, but shall render your oaths to the Lord.

34 But I say to you not to swear at all, neither by heaven, because it is God's throne,

35 nor by earth, because it is the footstool of his feet, nor toward Hierosolyma, because it is the city of the great King,

36 nor shall you swear by your head, because you cannot make one hair white or black.

37 And let your word be: Yes, yes; no, no; and what exceeds these is from the evil one.

38 You heard that it was said: An eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth.

39 But I say to you not to resist the evil one; but whoever slaps you upon your right cheek, turn to him the other also,

40 and to the one wishing to litigate with you and take your tunic, leave him your cloak also,

41 and whoever compels you to go one mile, go with him two.

42 Give to the one asking you, and do not turn away the one wishing to borrow from you.

43 You heard that it was said: You shall love your neighbor and hate your enemy.

44 But I say to you: Love your enemies, bless those cursing you, do good to those hating you, and pray for those abusing you and persecuting you,

45 so that you may become sons of your Father in the heavens, because he makes his sun rise upon evil and good people and sends rain upon righteous and unrighteous people.

46 For if you love those loving you, what reward do you have? Do not even the tax collectors do the same?

47 And if you greet only your brothers, what more do you do? Do not even the tax collectors do thus?

48 Therefore you shall be perfect, just as your Father in the heavens is perfect.

Chapter 6

1 Take heed not to do your almsgiving before humans to be seen by them; otherwise you have no reward with your Father in the heavens.

2 Therefore when you do almsgiving, do not trumpet before you, just as the hypocrites do in the synagogues and in the lanes, so that they may be glorified by humans; amen, I say to you: they have received their reward.

3 But when you do almsgiving, let your left hand not know what your right hand does,

4 so that your almsgiving may be in secret, and your Father who sees in secret, he shall repay you openly.

5 And when you pray, you shall not be just as the hypocrites, because they love to pray standing in the synagogues and at the corners of the streets, so that they may appear to humans; amen, I say to you that they have received their reward.

6 But you, when you pray, enter your inner chamber, and closing your door, pray to your Father in secret, and your Father who sees in secret shall repay you openly.

7 And when praying, do not babble just as the nations do; for they think that they shall be heard through their many words.

8 Therefore do not become like them, for your Father knows what you have need of before you ask him.

9 Therefore pray thus: Our Father in the heavens, let your name be sanctified;

10 let your kingdom come; let your will be done, as in heaven, also upon the earth;

11 give us today our daily bread;

12 and forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors;

13 and do not bring us into temptation, but rescue us from the evil one.

14 For if you forgive humans their transgressions, your heavenly Father shall forgive you also;

15 but if you do not forgive humans their transgressions, neither shall your Father forgive your transgressions.

16 And when you fast, do not become gloomy just as the hypocrites, for they disfigure their faces so that they may appear to humans to be fasting; amen, I say to you that they have received their reward.

17 But you, fasting, anoint your head and wash your face,

18 so that you may not appear to humans to be fasting, but to your Father in secret; and your Father who sees in secret shall repay you openly.

19 Do not store up treasures for yourselves upon the earth, where moth and consumption destroy and where thieves dig through and steal;

20 but store up treasures for yourselves in heaven, where neither moth nor consumption destroys and where thieves do not dig through or steal.

21 For where your treasure is, there your heart shall be also.

22 The lamp of the body is the eye; therefore if your eye is simple, your whole body shall be luminous;

23 but if your eye is evil, your whole body shall be dark. Therefore if the light in you is darkness, how great the darkness!

24 No one can serve two lords; for either he shall hate the one and love the other, or hold to one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon.

25 Therefore I say to you: Do not be anxious for your soul, what you shall eat and what you shall drink, nor for your body, what you shall put on. Is not the soul more than food and the body than clothing?

26 Look at the birds of heaven, because they do not sow or reap or gather into storehouses, and your heavenly Father feeds them. Do you not differ from them much more?

27 And who among you, being anxious, can add one cubit to his stature?

28 And why are you anxious concerning clothing? Consider the lilies of the field, how they grow; they do not toil or spin;

29 and I say to you that not even Solomon in all his glory was clothed like one of these.

30 And if God thus clothes the grass of the field, which is today and tomorrow is thrown into an oven, shall he not much more clothe you, you of little faith?

31 Therefore do not be anxious, saying: What shall we eat? Or: What shall we drink? Or: What shall we put on?

32 For the nations seek all these things; for your heavenly Father knows that you need all these things.

33 But seek first the kingdom of God and his righteousness, and all these things shall be added to you.

34 Therefore do not be anxious for tomorrow, for tomorrow shall be anxious for its own things; sufficient for the day is its evil.

Chapter 7

1 Do not judge, so that you may not be judged;

2 for with the judgment with which you judge you shall be judged, and with the measure with which you measure it shall be measured back to you.

3 And why do you look at the speck in your brother's eye, but do not consider the beam in your own eye?

4 Or how shall you say to your brother: Let me cast the speck out of your eye, and behold, the beam is in your eye?

5 Hypocrite, first cast the beam out of your eye, and then you shall see clearly to cast the speck out of your brother's eye.

6 Do not give what is holy to the dogs, nor throw your pearls before the pigs, lest they trample them with their feet and turn and tear you.

7 Ask, and it shall be given to you; seek, and you shall find; knock, and it shall be opened to you.

8 For everyone asking receives, and the one seeking finds, and to the one knocking it shall be opened.

9 Or what human is there among you who, if his son asks for bread, shall give him a stone?

10 And if he asks for a fish, shall he give him a serpent?

11 Therefore if you, being evil, know to give good gifts to your children, how much more shall your Father in the heavens give good things to those asking him?

12 Therefore all things whatsoever you wish humans to do to you, thus also do to them; for this is the law and the prophets.

13 Enter through the narrow gate, because broad is the gate and spacious the way leading away to destruction, and many are those entering through it;

14 because narrow is the gate and constricted the way leading away to life, and few are those finding it.

15 And take heed of the false prophets, who come to you in sheep's garments, but within are ravenous wolves.

16 From their fruits you shall recognize them. Do they gather grapes from thorns or figs from thistles?

17 Thus every good tree produces good fruits, but the rotten tree produces evil fruits.

18 A good tree cannot produce evil fruits, nor a rotten tree produce good fruits.

19 Every tree not producing good fruit is cut down and thrown into fire.

20 Therefore indeed from their fruits you shall recognize them.

21 Not everyone saying to me: Lord, Lord, shall enter the kingdom of the heavens, but the one doing the will of my Father in the heavens.

22 Many shall say to me on that day: Lord, Lord, did we not prophesy in your name and cast out demons in your name and do many mighty works in your name?

23 And then I shall declare to them: I never knew you; depart from me, you who work lawlessness.

24 Therefore everyone who hears these words of mine and does them, I shall liken him to a prudent man who built his house upon the rock;

25 and the rain descended and the rivers came and the winds blew and fell against that house, and it did not fall, for it had been founded upon the rock.

26 And everyone hearing these words of mine and not doing them shall be likened to a foolish man who built his house upon the sand;

27 and the rain descended and the rivers came and the winds blew and struck that house, and it fell, and its fall was great.

28 And it happened, when Jesus completed these words, the crowds were astonished at his teaching,

29 for he was teaching them as one having authority and not as the scribes.

Chapter 8

1 And when he came down from the mountain, many crowds followed him.

2 And behold, a leper came and worshipped him, saying: Lord, if you wish, you can cleanse me.

3 And Jesus stretched out his hand and touched him, saying: I wish; be cleansed. And immediately his leprosy was cleansed.

4 And Jesus says to him: See that you tell no one, but go, show yourself to the priest and offer the gift which Moses commanded, for a testimony to them.

5 And when Jesus entered Capernaoum, a centurion approached him, appealing to him

6 and saying: Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, terribly tormented.

7 And Jesus says to him: I shall come and heal him.

8 And the centurion answered and said: Lord, I am not sufficient for you to enter under my roof, but only say a word, and my servant shall be healed.

9 For I also am a human under authority, having soldiers under myself, and I say to this one: Go, and he goes, and to another: Come, and he comes, and to my slave: Do this, and he does it.

10 And Jesus, hearing, wondered and said to those following: Amen, I say to you: not even in Israel did I find such faith.

11 And I say to you that many shall come from east and west and recline with Abraam and Isaak and Iakob in the kingdom of the heavens;

12 but the sons of the kingdom shall be cast out into the outer darkness; there shall be weeping and gnashing of teeth.

13 And Jesus said to the centurion: Go, and as you believed, let it happen for you. And his servant was healed at that hour.

14 And Jesus came into Peter's house and saw his mother-in-law lying down and feverish,

15 and touched her hand, and the fever left her, and she rose and ministered to them.

16 And when evening came, they brought to him many possessed by demons, and he cast out the spirits with a word and healed all those who were ill,

17 so that what was spoken through Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, saying: He took our weaknesses and bore the diseases.

18 And Jesus, seeing many crowds around him, commanded to depart to the other side.

19 And one scribe approached and said to him: Teacher, I shall follow you wherever you go.

20 And Jesus says to him: The foxes have dens and the birds of heaven dwelling places, but the Son of man has nowhere to lay his head.

21 And another of his disciples said to him: Lord, permit me first to go away and bury my father.

22 But Jesus said to him: Follow me, and leave the dead to bury their own dead.

23 And when he entered the boat, his disciples followed him.

24 And behold, a great shaking happened in the sea, so that the boat was covered by the waves; but he slept.

25 And his disciples approached and awakened him, saying: Lord, save us, we are perishing.

26 And he says to them: Why are you cowardly, you of little faith? Then rising, he rebuked the winds and the sea, and a great calm came.

27 And the humans wondered, saying: What sort of one is this, that even the winds and the sea obey him?

28 And when he came to the other side, to the country of the Gergesenes, two possessed by demons met him, coming out of the tombs, exceedingly fierce, so that no one could pass by that way.

29 And behold, they cried, saying: What is there between us and you, Jesus, son of God? Did you come here before the time to torment us?

30 And far from them there was a herd of many pigs feeding.

31 And the demons appealed to him, saying: If you cast us out, permit us to go into the herd of pigs.

32 And he said to them: Go. And coming out, they went into the herd of pigs, and behold, the whole herd of pigs rushed down the cliff into the sea and died in the waters.

33 And those feeding them fled, and going into the city announced everything, and the things concerning those possessed by demons.

34 And behold, the whole city came out to meet Jesus, and seeing him they appealed that he depart from their boundaries.

Chapter 9

1 And entering the boat he crossed over and came into his own city.

2 And behold, they brought to him a paralytic lying upon a bed, and Jesus, seeing their faith, said to the paralytic: Take courage, child; your sins are forgiven you.

3 And behold, some of the scribes said within themselves: This one blasphemes.

4 And Jesus, seeing their thoughts, said: Why do you think evil things in your hearts?

5 For which is easier, to say: Your sins are forgiven you, or to say: Rise and walk?

6 But so that you may know that the Son of man has authority upon the earth to forgive sins—then he says to the paralytic: Rise, take up your bed and go to your house.

7 And rising, he went away to his house.

8 And the crowds, seeing, wondered and glorified God who gave such authority to humans.

9 And Jesus, passing on from there, saw a human sitting at the tax office, called Matthew, and says to him: Follow me. And rising, he followed him.

10 And it happened, as he reclined in the house, and behold, many tax collectors and sinners came and reclined together with Jesus and his disciples.

11 And the Pharisees, seeing, said to his disciples: Why does your teacher eat with tax collectors and sinners?

12 And Jesus, hearing, said to them: Those who are strong have no need of a physician, but those who are ill.

13 But go and learn what this is: I wish mercy and not sacrifice; for I did not come to call righteous people, but sinners to repentance.

14 Then John's disciples approach him, saying: Why do we and the Pharisees fast much, but your disciples do not fast?

15 And Jesus said to them: Can the sons of the bridal chamber mourn as long as the bridegroom is with them? But days shall come when the bridegroom is taken away from them, and then they shall fast.

16 And no one puts a patch of unfulled cloth upon an old garment, for its filling pulls away from the garment, and a worse tear happens.

17 Nor do they put new wine into old wineskins; otherwise the wineskins burst and the wine is poured out and the wineskins perish; but they put new wine into fresh wineskins, and both are preserved.

18 While he spoke these things to them, behold, a ruler came and worshipped him, saying: My daughter has just died, but come and place your hand upon her, and she shall live.

19 And Jesus rose and followed him, and his disciples.

20 And behold, a woman hemorrhaging twelve years approached from behind and touched the fringe of his garment,

21 for she said within herself: If I only touch his garment, I shall be saved.

22 And Jesus turned and saw her and said: Take courage, daughter; your faith has saved you. And the woman was saved from that hour.

23 And Jesus came into the ruler's house and saw the flute players and the crowd in an uproar,

24 and says to them: Withdraw, for the girl did not die, but sleeps. And they laughed at him.

25 But when the crowd was cast out, he entered and took hold of her hand, and the girl was raised.

26 And this report went out into all that land.

27 And as Jesus passed on from there, two blind men followed him, crying and saying: Have mercy on us, son of Dabid.

28 And when he came into the house, the blind men approached him, and Jesus says to them: Do you believe that I can do this? They say to him: Yes, Lord.

29 Then he touched their eyes, saying: According to your faith let it happen for you.

30 And their eyes were opened, and Jesus sternly warned them, saying: See that no one knows.

31 But going out, they spread the report of him in all that land.

32 And as they went out, behold, they brought to him a mute human possessed by a demon,

33 and when the demon was cast out, the mute spoke, and the crowds wondered, saying: Never did it appear thus in Israel.

34 But the Pharisees said: By the ruler of the demons he casts out demons.

35 And Jesus went around all the cities and the villages, teaching in their synagogues and proclaiming the good news of the kingdom and healing every disease and every infirmity among the people.

36 And seeing the crowds, he had compassion concerning them, because they were exhausted and cast down, like sheep not having a shepherd.

37 Then he says to his disciples: The harvest indeed is great, but the workers few;

38 therefore supplicate the Lord of the harvest, that he send out workers into his harvest.

Chapter 10

1 And calling his twelve disciples to him, he gave them authority over unclean spirits, so as to cast them out and heal every disease and every infirmity.

2 And the names of the twelve apostles are these: first Simon called Peter, and Andrew his brother, Iakobos the son of Zebedaios and John his brother,

3 Philip and Bartholomaios, Thomas and Matthew the tax collector, Iakobos the son of Alphaios and Lebbaios surnamed Thaddaios,

4 Simon the Kananite and Ioudas Iskariotes, who also handed him over.

5 These twelve Jesus sent out, commanding them, saying: Do not go into a way of nations, and do not enter a city of Samaritans;

6 but go rather to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

7 And as you go, proclaim, saying that the kingdom of the heavens has drawn near.

8 Heal the sick, cleanse lepers, raise the dead, cast out demons; freely you received, freely give.

9 Do not acquire gold or silver or bronze for your belts,

10 no bag for the way, nor two tunics nor sandals nor a staff; for the worker is worthy of his food.

11 And whatever city or village you enter, inquire who in it is worthy, and remain there until you go out.

12 And as you enter the house, greet it,

13 and if the house is worthy, let your peace come upon it; but if it is not worthy, let your peace return to you.

14 And whoever does not receive you or hear your words, as you go out of that house or city, shake off the dust of your feet.

15 Amen, I say to you: it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodoma and Gomorra on the day of judgment than for that city.

16 Behold, I send you as sheep in the midst of wolves; therefore become prudent as the serpents and unmixed as the doves.

17 And take heed of humans, for they shall hand you over to councils and flog you in their synagogues,

18 and you shall also be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony to them and the nations.

19 And when they hand you over, do not be anxious how or what you shall speak, for what you shall speak shall be given to you at that hour;

20 for you are not those speaking, but the Spirit of your Father who speaks in you.

21 And brother shall hand over brother to death, and father a child, and children shall rise against parents and put them to death,

22 and you shall be hated by all because of my name; but the one enduring to the end, this one shall be saved.

23 And when they persecute you in this city, flee to the other; for amen, I say to you: you shall certainly not finish the cities of Israel until the Son of man comes.

24 A disciple is not above the teacher, nor a slave above his lord.

25 It is sufficient for the disciple to become as his teacher and the slave as his lord. If they called the master of the house Beelzeboul, how much more his household members?

26 Therefore do not fear them, for there is nothing covered which shall not be uncovered, and hidden which shall not be known.

27 What I say to you in the darkness, say in the light, and what you hear in the ear, proclaim upon the housetops.

28 And do not fear those killing the body but unable to kill the soul; but fear rather the one able to destroy both soul and body in Gehenna.

29 Are not two sparrows sold for an assarion? And one of them shall not fall upon the earth without your Father.

30 And even the hairs of your head are all numbered.

31 Therefore do not fear; you differ from many sparrows.

32 Therefore everyone who acknowledges me before humans, I also shall acknowledge him before my Father in the heavens;

33 but whoever denies me before humans, I also shall deny him before my Father in the heavens.

34 Do not think that I came to cast peace upon the earth; I did not come to cast peace, but a sword.

35 For I came to divide a human against his father, and a daughter against her mother, and a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law,

36 and a human's enemies are his household members.

37 The one loving father or mother above me is not worthy of me, and the one loving son or daughter above me is not worthy of me,

38 and whoever does not take his cross and follow after me is not worthy of me.

39 The one finding his soul shall lose it, and the one losing his soul for my sake shall find it.

40 The one receiving you receives me, and the one receiving me receives the one who sent me.

41 The one receiving a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet's reward, and the one receiving a righteous person in the name of a righteous person shall receive a righteous person's reward.

42 And whoever gives one of these little ones only a cup of cold water to drink in the name of a disciple, amen, I say to you: he shall certainly not lose his reward.

Chapter 11

1 And it happened, when Jesus finished giving orders to his twelve disciples, he departed from there to teach and proclaim in their cities.

2 And John, hearing in prison the works of the Christ, sent two of his disciples

3 and said to him: Are you the coming one, or do we await another?

4 And Jesus answered and said to them: Go and announce to John what you hear and see:

5 blind people regain sight and lame people walk, lepers are cleansed and deaf people hear, dead people are raised and poor people are given good news,

6 and blessed is whoever does not stumble because of me.

7 And as these went, Jesus began to say to the crowds concerning John: What did you go out into the wilderness to behold? A reed shaken by wind?

8 But what did you go out to see? A human clothed in soft garments? Behold, those wearing soft things are in the houses of kings.

9 But what did you go out to see? A prophet? Yes, I say to you, and more than a prophet.

10 For this is the one concerning whom it is written: Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who shall prepare your way before you.

11 Amen, I say to you: among those born of women none greater than John the Baptist has arisen; but the lesser in the kingdom of the heavens is greater than he.

12 And from the days of John the Baptist until now the kingdom of the heavens suffers violence, and violent ones seize it.

13 For all the prophets and the law prophesied until John,

14 and if you wish to receive it, he is Elias who is to come.

15 The one having ears to hear, let him hear.

16 And to what shall I liken this generation? It is like children sitting in marketplaces and calling to their companions

17 and saying: We played the flute for you, and you did not dance; we lamented for you, and you did not beat your breasts.

18 For John came neither eating nor drinking, and they say: He has a demon.

19 The Son of man came eating and drinking, and they say: Behold, a gluttonous human and a wine drinker, a friend of tax collectors and sinners. And wisdom was justified by her children.

20 Then he began to reproach the cities in which most of his mighty works happened, because they did not repent:

21 Woe to you, Chorazin; woe to you, Bethsaida; because if the mighty works which happened in you had happened in Tyre and Sidon, they would have repented long ago in sackcloth and ashes.

22 Nevertheless I say to you: it shall be more tolerable for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment than for you.

23 And you, Capernaoum, who were exalted unto heaven, shall be brought down unto Hades; because if the mighty works which happened in you had happened in Sodoma, they would have remained until today.

24 Nevertheless I say to you that it shall be more tolerable for the land of Sodoma on the day of judgment than for you.

25 At that time Jesus answered and said: I give thanks to you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth, because you hid these things from wise and understanding people and revealed them to infants.

26 Yes, Father, because thus it became pleasing before you.

27 All things were handed over to me by my Father, and no one knows the Son except the Father, nor does anyone know the Father except the Son and whoever the Son wishes to reveal him to.

28 Come to me, all who toil and are burdened, and I shall give you rest.

29 Take my yoke upon you and learn from me, because I am meek and lowly in heart, and you shall find rest for your souls;

30 for my yoke is good and my burden light.

Chapter 12

1 At that time Jesus went through the grainfields on the sabbaths, and his disciples hungered and began to pluck ears of grain and eat.

2 And the Pharisees, seeing, said to him: Behold, your disciples do what it is not lawful to do on a sabbath.

3 And he said to them: Did you not read what Dabid did when he hungered, he and those with him,

4 how he entered the house of God and ate the breads of presentation, which it was not lawful for him to eat, nor for those with him, except for the priests alone?

5 Or did you not read in the law that on the sabbaths the priests in the temple profane the sabbath and are guiltless?

6 And I say to you that one greater than the temple is here.

7 But if you had known what this is: I wish mercy and not sacrifice, you would not have condemned the guiltless.

8 For the Son of man is lord even of the sabbath.

9 And departing from there he came into their synagogue,

10 and behold, there was a human having a withered hand, and they questioned him, saying: Is it lawful to heal on the sabbaths? So that they might accuse him.

11 And he said to them: What human shall there be among you who shall have one sheep, and if it falls into a pit on the sabbaths, shall he not take hold of it and raise it?

12 Therefore how much does a human differ from a sheep! So it is lawful to do good on the sabbaths.

13 Then he says to the human: Stretch out your hand. And he stretched it out, and it was restored healthy as the other.

14 And the Pharisees went out and took counsel against him, how they might destroy him.

15 But Jesus, knowing, withdrew from there, and many crowds followed him, and he healed them all

16 and rebuked them so that they might not make him manifest,

17 so that what was spoken through Esaias the prophet might be fulfilled, saying:

18 Behold, my servant whom I chose, my beloved in whom my soul was well pleased; I shall place my Spirit upon him, and he shall announce judgment to the nations.

19 He shall not quarrel or cry out, nor shall anyone hear his voice in the streets;

20 a broken reed he shall not break off, and smoking flax he shall not extinguish, until he brings out judgment unto victory,

21 and in his name nations shall hope.

22 Then one possessed by a demon, blind and mute, was brought to him, and he healed him, so that the blind and mute one both spoke and saw.

23 And all the crowds were astonished and said: Could this be the son of Dabid?

24 But the Pharisees, hearing, said: This one does not cast out demons except by Beelzeboul, ruler of the demons.

25 And Jesus, knowing their thoughts, said to them: Every kingdom divided against itself is desolated, and every city or house divided against itself shall not stand.

26 And if Satan casts out Satan, he was divided against himself; therefore how shall his kingdom stand?

27 And if I cast out demons by Beelzeboul, by whom do your sons cast them out? Therefore they shall be your judges.

28 But if I cast out demons by the Spirit of God, then the kingdom of God has reached you.

29 Or how can anyone enter the house of the strong one and plunder his goods, unless he first binds the strong one? And then he shall plunder his house.

30 The one not being with me is against me, and the one not gathering with me scatters.

31 Therefore I say to you: every sin and blasphemy shall be forgiven humans, but the blasphemy of the Spirit shall not be forgiven humans.

32 And whoever says a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him; but whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit, it shall not be forgiven him, neither in this age nor in the coming one.

33 Either make the tree good and its fruit good, or make the tree rotten and its fruit rotten; for from the fruit the tree is known.

34 Offspring of vipers, how can you speak good things, being evil? For from the abundance of the heart the mouth speaks.

35 The good human brings out good things from the good treasure of the heart, and the evil human brings out evil things from the evil treasure.

36 And I say to you that every idle saying which humans speak, they shall render an account concerning it on the day of judgment;

37 for from your words you shall be justified, and from your words you shall be condemned.

38 Then some of the scribes and Pharisees answered, saying: Teacher, we wish to see a sign from you.

39 And he answered and said to them: An evil and adulterous generation seeks a sign, and a sign shall not be given to it except the sign of Ionas the prophet.

40 For just as Ionas was in the belly of the sea creature three days and three nights, thus the Son of man shall be in the heart of the earth three days and three nights.

41 Ninevite men shall rise in the judgment with this generation and condemn it, because they repented at the proclamation of Ionas, and behold, more than Ionas is here.

42 A queen of the south shall be raised in the judgment with this generation and condemn it, because she came from the ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon, and behold, more than Solomon is here.

43 And when the unclean spirit comes out from the human, it passes through waterless places seeking rest and does not find it.

44 Then it says: I shall return to my house from which I came out. And coming, it finds it unoccupied, swept and adorned.

45 Then it goes and takes with itself seven other spirits more evil than itself, and entering they dwell there, and the last things of that human become worse than the first. Thus it shall be also for this evil generation.

46 And while he still spoke to the crowds, behold, his mother and brothers stood outside, seeking to speak to him.

47 And someone said to him: Behold, your mother and your brothers stand outside, seeking to speak to you.

48 And he answered and said to the one who told him: Who is my mother, and who are my brothers?

49 And stretching out his hand toward his disciples, he said: Behold, my mother and my brothers;

50 for whoever does the will of my Father in the heavens, he is my brother and sister and mother.

Chapter 13

1 And on that day Jesus went out of the house and was sitting beside the sea.

2 And many crowds gathered to him, so that he entered the boat and sat down, and the whole crowd stood on the shore.

3 And he spoke many things to them in parables, saying: Behold, the sower went out to sow.

4 And as he sowed, some fell beside the road, and the birds came and devoured them.

5 And others fell on the rocky places, where they did not have much earth, and immediately sprang up because they had no depth of earth.

6 And when the sun rose, they were scorched, and because they had no root, they withered.

7 And others fell upon the thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked them.

8 And others fell upon the good earth and were giving fruit, one a hundred, another sixty, and another thirty.

9 He who has ears to hear, let him hear.

10 And the disciples approached and said to him: Why do you speak to them in parables?

11 And he answered and said to them: Because to you it has been given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of the heavens, but to them it has not been given.

12 For whoever has, to him it shall be given, and he shall have abundance; but whoever does not have, even what he has shall be taken from him.

13 For this reason I speak to them in parables: because seeing they do not see, and hearing they do not hear, nor do they understand.

14 And in them the prophecy of Isaiah is fulfilled, which says: With hearing you shall hear and shall certainly not understand, and seeing you shall see and shall certainly not perceive.

15 For the heart of this people has grown fat, and with their ears they heard heavily, and they closed their eyes, lest they see with their eyes and hear with their ears and understand with their heart and turn, and I heal them.

16 But blessed are your eyes, because they see, and your ears, because they hear.

17 For amen, I say to you that many prophets and righteous men desired to see what you see and did not see, and to hear what you hear and did not hear.

18 You, therefore, hear the parable of the sower.

19 When anyone hears the word of the kingdom and does not understand, the evil one comes and snatches away what was sown in his heart. This is the one sown beside the road.

20 And the one sown on the rocky places, this is the one who hears the word and immediately receives it with joy.

21 But he has no root in himself, but is temporary; and when affliction or persecution arises because of the word, immediately he is made to stumble.

22 And the one sown among the thorns, this is the one who hears the word, and the care of this age and the deceit of wealth choke the word, and he becomes unfruitful.

23 And the one sown upon the good earth, this is the one who hears the word and understands, who indeed bears fruit and produces, one a hundred, another sixty, and another thirty.

24 He set another parable before them, saying: The kingdom of the heavens was likened to a man sowing good seed in his field.

25 But while the men slept, his enemy came and sowed darnel among the wheat and went away.

26 And when the blade sprouted and produced fruit, then the darnel also appeared.

27 And the slaves of the master of the house approached and said to him: Lord, did you not sow good seed in your field? From where, then, does it have the darnel?

28 And he said to them: An enemy man did this. And the slaves said to him: Do you wish, then, that we go and gather them?

29 But he said: No, lest in gathering the darnel you uproot the wheat together with them.

30 Let both grow together until the harvest, and at the time of the harvest I shall say to the harvesters: Gather the darnel first and bind them into bundles to burn them up, but gather the wheat into my storehouse.

31 He set another parable before them, saying: The kingdom of the heavens is like a grain of mustard, which a man took and sowed in his field.

32 Which is indeed smaller than all the seeds, but when it grows, it is greater than the garden plants and becomes a tree, so that the birds of the heaven come and dwell in its branches.

33 He spoke another parable to them: The kingdom of the heavens is like leaven, which a woman took and hid in three sata of flour, until the whole was leavened.

34 Jesus spoke all these things to the crowds in parables, and without a parable he did not speak to them,

35 so that what was spoken through the prophet might be fulfilled, saying: I shall open my mouth in parables; I shall utter things hidden from the foundation of the world.

36 Then Jesus left the crowds and came into the house, and his disciples approached him, saying: Explain to us the parable of the darnel of the field.

37 And he answered and said to them: The one sowing the good seed is the Son of man.

38 And the field is the world, and the good seed, these are the sons of the kingdom; and the darnel are the sons of the evil one.

39 And the enemy who sowed them is the devil, and the harvest is the completion of the age, and the harvesters are angels.

40 Therefore, just as the darnel is gathered and burned up with fire, so shall it be at the completion of this age.

41 The Son of man shall send his angels, and they shall gather out of his kingdom all the stumbling blocks and those who practice lawlessness,

42 and shall cast them into the furnace of fire. There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth.

43 Then the righteous shall shine out like the sun in the kingdom of their Father. He who has ears to hear, let him hear.

44 Again, the kingdom of the heavens is like a treasure hidden in the field, which a man found and hid, and from his joy he goes and sells everything he has and buys that field.

45 Again, the kingdom of the heavens is like a merchant man seeking beautiful pearls,

46 who, having found one very precious pearl, went away and sold everything he had and bought it.

47 Again, the kingdom of the heavens is like a dragnet cast into the sea and gathering from every kind,

48 which, when it was filled, they drew up onto the shore, and sitting down they gathered the good into vessels, but cast the rotten outside.

49 So shall it be at the completion of the age: the angels shall come out and separate the evil from the midst of the righteous,

50 and shall cast them into the furnace of fire. There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth.

51 Jesus says to them: Have you understood all these things? They say to him: Yes, Lord.

52 And he said to them: For this reason every scribe who has been made a disciple for the kingdom of the heavens is like a master of a house who brings out of his treasure new things and old.

53 And it happened, when Jesus finished these parables, he departed from there.

54 And coming into his homeland, he was teaching them in their synagogue, so that they were astonished and said: From where does this man have this wisdom and the mighty works?

55 Is this not the carpenter's son? Is his mother not called Mariam, and his brothers James and Joses and Simon and Judas?

56 And his sisters, are they not all with us? From where, then, does this man have all these things?

57 And they were made to stumble at him. But Jesus said to them: A prophet is not without honor except in his homeland and in his house.

58 And he did not perform many mighty works there because of their unbelief.

Chapter 14

1 At that time Herod the tetrarch heard the report of Jesus,

2 and said to his servants: This is John the Baptist; he was raised from the dead, and for this reason the powers work in him.

3 For Herod had seized John and bound him and put him in prison because of Herodias, the wife of Philip his brother.

4 For John was saying to him: It is not lawful for you to have her.

5 And wishing to kill him, he feared the crowd, because they held him as a prophet.

6 And while Herod's birthday was being celebrated, the daughter of Herodias danced in the midst and pleased Herod,

7 whereupon he promised her with an oath to give whatever she might ask.

8 And she, prompted by her mother, says: Give me here on a platter the head of John the Baptist.

9 And the king was grieved, but because of the oaths and those reclining with him, he commanded it to be given.

10 And sending, he beheaded John in the prison.

11 And his head was brought on a platter and given to the girl, and she brought it to her mother.

12 And his disciples approached and took the body and buried it, and came and reported to Jesus.

13 And hearing, Jesus withdrew from there in a boat to a deserted place privately. And hearing, the crowds followed him on foot from the cities.

14 And coming out, Jesus saw a great crowd and had compassion on them and healed their sick.

15 And when evening came, his disciples approached him, saying: The place is deserted, and the hour has already passed; dismiss the crowds so that they may go into the villages and buy food for themselves.

16 But Jesus said to them: They have no need to go away; you give them something to eat.

17 And they say to him: We have nothing here except five loaves and two fish.

18 And he said: Bring them here to me.

19 And commanding the crowds to recline on the grass, and taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up into the heaven and blessed, and breaking, he gave the loaves to the disciples, and the disciples to the crowds.

20 And all ate and were filled, and they took up the surplus of the fragments, twelve baskets full.

21 And those eating were about five thousand men, apart from women and children.

22 And immediately Jesus compelled his disciples to enter the boat and go ahead of him to the other side, until he should dismiss the crowds.

23 And dismissing the crowds, he went up into the mountain privately to pray. And when evening came, he was there alone.

24 But the boat was already in the middle of the sea, tormented by the waves, for the wind was contrary.

25 And in the fourth watch of the night Jesus went toward them, walking upon the sea.

26 And the disciples, seeing him walking upon the sea, were troubled, saying: It is an apparition. And they cried out from fear.

27 But immediately Jesus spoke to them, saying: Take courage; I am; do not fear.

28 And Peter answered him and said: Lord, if it is you, command me to come to you upon the waters.

29 And he said: Come. And Peter went down from the boat and walked upon the waters to come to Jesus.

30 But seeing the strong wind, he feared, and beginning to sink, he cried out, saying: Lord, save me.

31 And immediately Jesus stretched out his hand and took hold of him, and says to him: You of little faith, why did you doubt?

32 And when they entered the boat, the wind ceased.

33 And those in the boat came and worshiped him, saying: Truly you are God's Son.

34 And crossing over, they came into the land of Gennesaret.

35 And recognizing him, the men of that place sent into that whole surrounding region, and brought to him all who were ill,

36 and begged him that they might only touch the fringe of his garment; and as many as touched were saved.

Chapter 15

1 Then the scribes and Pharisees from Jerusalem approach Jesus, saying:

2 Why do your disciples transgress the tradition of the elders? For they do not wash their hands when they eat bread.

3 And he answered and said to them: Why do you also transgress the commandment of God because of your tradition?

4 For God commanded, saying: Honor your father and mother; and: He who speaks evil of father or mother, let him die by death.

5 But you say: Whoever says to his father or mother: Whatever you might benefit from me is a gift,

6 and shall certainly not honor his father or his mother. And you made the commandment of God void because of your tradition.

7 Hypocrites, Isaiah prophesied well concerning you, saying:

8 This people approaches me with their mouth and honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me.

9 And in vain they worship me, teaching teachings, commandments of men.

10 And calling the crowd to him, he said to them: Hear and understand.

11 What enters into the mouth does not defile the man, but what goes out of the mouth, this defiles the man.

12 Then his disciples approached and said to him: Do you know that the Pharisees, hearing the word, were made to stumble?

13 And he answered and said: Every planting which my heavenly Father did not plant shall be uprooted.

14 Leave them; they are blind guides of the blind. And if a blind man guides a blind man, both shall fall into a pit.

15 And Peter answered and said to him: Explain this parable to us.

16 And Jesus said: Are you also still without understanding?

17 Do you not yet perceive that everything entering into the mouth goes into the belly and is cast out into the latrine?

18 But the things going out of the mouth come out of the heart, and those defile the man.

19 For out of the heart come evil reasonings, murders, adulteries, fornications, thefts, false testimonies, blasphemies.

20 These are the things defiling the man, but eating with unwashed hands does not defile the man.

21 And Jesus went out from there and withdrew into the regions of Tyre and Sidon.

22 And behold, a Canaanite woman came out from those borders and cried out to him, saying: Have mercy on me, Lord, Son of David; my daughter is badly demon-possessed.

23 But he did not answer her a word. And his disciples approached and asked him, saying: Dismiss her, because she cries out behind us.

24 And he answered and said: I was not sent except to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.

25 And she came and worshiped him, saying: Lord, help me.

26 And he answered and said: It is not good to take the children's bread and cast it to the little dogs.

27 And she said: Yes, Lord, for even the little dogs eat from the crumbs falling from their masters' table.

28 Then Jesus answered and said to her: O woman, great is your faith; let it happen to you as you wish. And her daughter was healed from that hour.

29 And departing from there, Jesus came beside the sea of Galilee, and going up into the mountain, he was sitting there.

30 And many crowds approached him, having with them lame, blind, mute, maimed, and many others, and cast them beside Jesus' feet, and he healed them,

31 so that the crowds marveled, seeing the mute speaking, the maimed healthy, the lame walking, and the blind seeing; and they glorified the God of Israel.

32 And Jesus called his disciples to him and said: I have compassion on the crowd, because already they remain with me three days and have nothing to eat; and I do not wish to dismiss them fasting, lest they faint on the road.

33 And his disciples say to him: From where do we have so many loaves in a deserted place as to fill so great a crowd?

34 And Jesus says to them: How many loaves do you have? And they said: Seven, and a few little fish.

35 And he commanded the crowds to recline upon the earth.

36 And taking the seven loaves and the fish, he gave thanks and broke them and gave to his disciples, and the disciples to the crowd.

37 And all ate and were filled, and they took up the surplus of the fragments, seven large baskets full.

38 And those eating were four thousand men, apart from women and children.

39 And dismissing the crowds, he entered the boat and came into the borders of Magdala.

Chapter 16

1 And the Pharisees and Sadducees approached, testing him, and asked him to show them a sign from the heaven.

2 And he answered and said to them: When evening comes, you say: Fair weather, for the heaven is red.

3 And in the morning: Today a storm, for the heaven is red and gloomy. Hypocrites, you know how to discern the face of the heaven, but you cannot discern the signs of the times.

4 An evil and adulterous generation seeks a sign, and a sign shall not be given to it except the sign of Jonah the prophet. And leaving them, he went away.

5 And his disciples came to the other side and forgot to take loaves.

6 And Jesus said to them: See and beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees.

7 And they were reasoning among themselves, saying: Because we did not take loaves.

8 And Jesus knew and said to them: Why do you reason among yourselves, you of little faith, because you did not take loaves?

9 Do you not yet perceive, nor remember the five loaves of the five thousand, and how many baskets you took?

10 Nor the seven loaves of the four thousand, and how many large baskets you took?

11 How do you not perceive that I did not speak to you concerning bread, to beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and Sadducees?

12 Then they understood that he did not say to beware of the leaven of bread, but of the teaching of the Pharisees and Sadducees.

13 And Jesus came into the regions of Caesarea Philippi and was asking his disciples, saying: Who do men say that I, the Son of man, am?

14 And they said: Some John the Baptist, and others Elijah, and others Jeremiah or one of the prophets.

15 He says to them: But you, who do you say that I am?

16 And Simon Peter answered and said: You are the Christ, the Son of the living God.

17 And Jesus answered and said to him: Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah, because flesh and blood did not reveal this to you, but my Father who is in the heavens.

18 And I also say to you that you are Peter, and upon this rock I shall build my church, and the gates of Hades shall not prevail against it.

19 And I shall give you the keys of the kingdom of the heavens, and whatever you bind upon the earth shall be bound in the heavens, and whatever you loose upon the earth shall be loosed in the heavens.

20 Then he charged his disciples that they should tell no one that he is Jesus the Christ.

21 From then Jesus began to show his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem and suffer many things from the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and be raised on the third day.

22 And Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him, saying: Mercy to you, Lord; this shall certainly not happen to you.

23 But he turned and said to Peter: Go behind me, Satan; you are my stumbling block, because you do not mind the things of God, but the things of men.

24 Then Jesus said to his disciples: If anyone wishes to come behind me, let him deny himself and take up his cross and follow me.

25 For whoever wishes to save his soul shall lose it, but whoever loses his soul because of me shall find it.

26 For what does a man profit if he gains the whole world but suffers the loss of his soul? Or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

27 For the Son of man is about to come in the glory of his Father with his angels, and then he shall repay each according to his conduct.

28 Amen, I say to you: There are some of those standing here who shall certainly not taste death until they see the Son of man coming in his kingdom.

Chapter 17

1 And after six days Jesus takes Peter and James and John his brother with him, and brings them up into a high mountain privately.

2 And he was transfigured before them, and his face shone like the sun, and his garments became white like the light.

3 And behold, Moses and Elijah appeared to them, conversing with him.

4 And Peter answered and said to Jesus: Lord, it is good for us to be here; if you wish, let us make three tents here, one for you and one for Moses and one for Elijah.

5 While he was still speaking, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them, and behold, a voice from the cloud, saying: This is my beloved Son, in whom I was well pleased; hear him.

6 And hearing, the disciples fell upon their face and feared exceedingly.

7 And Jesus approached and touched them and said: Rise, and do not fear.

8 And lifting their eyes, they saw no one except Jesus alone.

9 And as they were descending from the mountain, Jesus commanded them, saying: Tell the vision to no one until the Son of man rises from the dead.

10 And his disciples questioned him, saying: Why, then, do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?

11 And Jesus answered and said to them: Elijah indeed comes first and shall restore all things.

12 But I say to you that Elijah already came, and they did not recognize him, but did to him whatever they wished. So also the Son of man is about to suffer by them.

13 Then the disciples understood that he spoke to them concerning John the Baptist.

14 And when they came to the crowd, a man approached him, kneeling to him,

15 and saying: Lord, have mercy on my son, because he is moon-struck and suffers badly; for often he falls into the fire and often into the water.

16 And I brought him to your disciples, and they were not able to heal him.

17 And Jesus answered and said: O unbelieving and perverted generation, until when shall I be with you? Until when shall I bear with you? Bring him here to me.

18 And Jesus rebuked him, and the demon came out from him, and the boy was healed from that hour.

19 Then the disciples approached Jesus privately and said: Why were we not able to cast it out?

20 And Jesus said to them: Because of your unbelief. For amen, I say to you: If you have faith like a grain of mustard, you shall say to this mountain: Move from here to there, and it shall move; and nothing shall be impossible for you.

21 But this kind does not go out except in prayer and fasting.

22 And while they were staying in Galilee, Jesus said to them: The Son of man is about to be handed over into the hands of men,

23 and they shall kill him, and on the third day he shall be raised. And they were exceedingly grieved.

24 And when they came to Capernaum, those receiving the two-drachma payments approached Peter and said: Does your teacher not pay the two drachmas?

25 He says: Yes. And when he entered the house, Jesus anticipated him, saying: What do you think, Simon? From whom do the kings of the earth receive duties or tax? From their sons or from strangers?

26 Peter says to him: From strangers. Jesus said to him: Then the sons are free.

27 But so that we do not make them stumble, go to the sea and cast a hook, and take the first fish that comes up, and opening its mouth you shall find a stater. Take that and give it to them for me and you.

Chapter 18

1 In that hour the disciples approached Jesus, saying: Who, then, is greater in the kingdom of the heavens?

2 And Jesus called a child to him and stood it in their midst,

3 and said: Amen, I say to you: Unless you turn and become like the children, you shall certainly not enter into the kingdom of the heavens.

4 Whoever, therefore, humbles himself like this child, this one is the greater in the kingdom of the heavens.

5 And whoever receives one such child in my name receives me.

6 But whoever makes one of these little ones who believe in me stumble, it is advantageous for him that a donkey millstone be hung around his neck and he be drowned in the depth of the sea.

7 Woe to the world because of the stumbling blocks! For it is necessary that the stumbling blocks come; nevertheless, woe to that man through whom the stumbling block comes!

8 And if your hand or your foot makes you stumble, cut them off and cast them from you. It is good for you to enter into life lame or maimed, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into the eternal fire.

9 And if your eye makes you stumble, take it out and cast it from you. It is good for you to enter into life one-eyed, rather than having two eyes to be cast into the Gehenna of fire.

10 See that you do not despise one of these little ones; for I say to you that their angels in the heavens continually see the face of my Father who is in the heavens.

11 For the Son of man came to save what was lost.

12 What do you think? If a certain man has a hundred sheep, and one of them wanders, does he not leave the ninety-nine upon the mountains and go and seek the wandering one?

13 And if he happens to find it, amen, I say to you that he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine that have not wandered.

14 So it is not the will before your Father who is in the heavens that one of these little ones perish.

15 And if your brother sins against you, go and reprove him between you and him alone. If he hears you, you have gained your brother.

16 But if he does not hear, take with you one or two more, so that upon the mouth of two witnesses or three every word may be established.

17 And if he refuses to hear them, tell the church; and if he also refuses to hear the church, let him be to you as the gentile and the tax collector.

18 Amen, I say to you: Whatever you bind upon the earth shall be bound in the heaven, and whatever you loose upon the earth shall be loosed in the heaven.

19 Again I say to you that if two of you agree upon the earth concerning any matter which they ask, it shall happen for them from my Father who is in the heavens.

20 For where two or three are gathered into my name, there I am in their midst.

21 Then Peter approached him and said: Lord, how often shall my brother sin against me and I forgive him? Until seven times?

22 Jesus says to him: I do not say to you until seven times, but until seventy times seven.

23 For this reason the kingdom of the heavens was likened to a king who wished to settle an account with his slaves.

24 And when he began to settle it, one debtor of ten thousand talents was brought to him.

25 And as he had nothing to repay, his lord commanded that he be sold, and his wife and the children and everything he had, and repayment be made.

26 Therefore the slave fell down and worshiped him, saying: Lord, be patient with me, and I shall repay you everything.

27 And the lord of that slave, having compassion, released him and forgave him the loan.

28 But that slave went out and found one of his fellow slaves who owed him a hundred denarii, and seizing him, he was choking him, saying: Repay me whatever you owe.

29 Therefore his fellow slave fell at his feet and begged him, saying: Be patient with me, and I shall repay you everything.

30 But he was unwilling, and went away and cast him into prison until he should repay what was owed.

31 And his fellow slaves, seeing what happened, were exceedingly grieved, and came and explained to their lord everything that happened.

32 Then his lord called him to him and says to him: Evil slave, I forgave you all that debt because you begged me.

33 Should you not also have had mercy on your fellow slave, as I also had mercy on you?

34 And his lord became angry and handed him over to the torturers until he should repay everything owed to him.

35 So also my heavenly Father shall do to you, unless you each forgive your brother their trespasses from your hearts.

Chapter 19

1 And it happened, when Jesus finished these words, he departed from Galilee and came into the borders of Judea beyond the Jordan.

2 And many crowds followed him, and he healed them there.

3 And the Pharisees approached him, testing him and saying to him: Is it lawful for a man to dismiss his wife for every cause?

4 And he answered and said to them: Have you not read that he who made them from the beginning made them male and female,

5 and said: Because of this a man shall leave father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall be into one flesh?

6 So that they are no longer two, but one flesh. What, therefore, God joined together, let man not separate.

7 They say to him: Why, then, did Moses command to give a document of divorce and dismiss her?

8 He says to them: Because Moses, in view of your hardness of heart, permitted you to dismiss your wives; but from the beginning it has not been so.

9 But I say to you that whoever dismisses his wife, except for fornication, and marries another commits adultery, and he who marries a dismissed woman commits adultery.

10 His disciples say to him: If the case of the man with the wife is so, it is not advantageous to marry.

11 And he said to them: Not all make room for this word, but those to whom it has been given.

12 For there are eunuchs who were born so from their mother's womb, and there are eunuchs who were made eunuchs by men, and there are eunuchs who made themselves eunuchs because of the kingdom of the heavens. He who is able to make room, let him make room.

13 Then children were brought to him, so that he might lay his hands upon them and pray; but the disciples rebuked them.

14 But Jesus said: Allow the children, and do not hinder them from coming to me, for of such is the kingdom of the heavens.

15 And laying his hands upon them, he went from there.

16 And behold, one approached and said to him: Good teacher, what good thing shall I do so that I may have eternal life?

17 And he said to him: Why do you call me good? No one is good except one, God. But if you wish to enter into life, keep the commandments.

18 He says to him: Which? And Jesus said: You shall not murder; you shall not commit adultery; you shall not steal; you shall not testify falsely;

19 honor your father and mother; and: You shall love your neighbor as yourself.

20 The young man says to him: All these I have kept from my youth; what do I still lack?

21 Jesus said to him: If you wish to be perfect, go, sell your possessions and give to the poor, and you shall have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me.

22 But hearing the word, the young man went away grieving, for he had many possessions.

23 And Jesus said to his disciples: Amen, I say to you that a rich man shall enter into the kingdom of the heavens with difficulty.

24 And again I say to you: It is easier for a camel to pass through the hole of a needle than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

25 And hearing, his disciples were exceedingly astonished, saying: Who, then, can be saved?

26 And Jesus looked at them and said to them: With men this is impossible, but with God all things are possible.

27 Then Peter answered and said to him: Behold, we left everything and followed you; what, then, shall there be for us?

28 And Jesus said to them: Amen, I say to you that you who followed me, in the regeneration, when the Son of man sits upon his throne of glory, you also shall sit upon twelve thrones, judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

29 And everyone who left houses or brothers or sisters or father or mother or wife or children or fields because of my name shall receive a hundredfold and shall inherit eternal life.

30 But many first shall be last, and last first.

Chapter 20

1 For the kingdom of the heavens is like a master of a house who went out early in the morning to hire workers into his vineyard.

2 And agreeing with the workers for a denarius for the day, he sent them into his vineyard.

3 And going out about the third hour, he saw others standing idle in the marketplace,

4 and said to those: You also go into the vineyard, and whatever is just I shall give you.

5 And they went away. Again going out about the sixth and ninth hour, he did likewise.

6 And going out about the eleventh hour, he found others standing idle, and says to them: Why have you stood here idle the whole day?

7 They say to him: Because no one hired us. He says to them: You also go into the vineyard, and whatever is just you shall receive.

8 And when evening came, the lord of the vineyard says to his steward: Call the workers and repay them the wage, beginning from the last until the first.

9 And those of about the eleventh hour came and received a denarius each.

10 And the first came and supposed that they would receive more, and they also received a denarius each.

11 And receiving it, they were grumbling against the master of the house,

12 saying: These last worked one hour, and you made them equal to us who bore the burden of the day and the scorching heat.

13 And he answered and said to one of them: Friend, I do not wrong you; did you not agree with me for a denarius?

14 Take what is yours and go; but I wish to give to this last one as also to you.

15 Or is it not lawful for me to do what I wish with my own things? Is your eye evil because I am good?

16 So the last shall be first, and the first last; for many are called, but few chosen.

17 And going up to Jerusalem, Jesus took the twelve disciples privately on the road and said to them:

18 Behold, we go up to Jerusalem, and the Son of man shall be handed over to the chief priests and scribes, and they shall condemn him to death,

19 and shall hand him over to the gentiles to mock and scourge and crucify, and on the third day he shall rise.

20 Then the mother of the sons of Zebedee approached him with her sons, worshiping and asking something from him.

21 And he said to her: What do you wish? She says to him: Say that these two sons of mine may sit, one at your right and one at your left, in your kingdom.

22 And Jesus answered and said: You do not know what you ask. Are you able to drink the cup which I am about to drink, and to be baptized with the baptism with which I am baptized? They say to him: We are able.

23 And he says to them: My cup indeed you shall drink, and with the baptism with which I am baptized you shall be baptized; but to sit at my right and at my left is not mine to give, but to those for whom it has been prepared by my Father.

24 And hearing, the ten were indignant concerning the two brothers.

25 And Jesus called them to him and said: You know that the rulers of the nations lord over them, and the great exercise authority over them.

26 But it shall not be so among you; rather, whoever wishes to become great among you, let him be your servant.

27 And whoever wishes to be first among you, let him be your slave,

28 just as the Son of man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his soul as a ransom for many.

29 And as they were going out from Jericho, a great crowd followed him.

30 And behold, two blind men sitting beside the road, hearing that Jesus was passing by, cried out, saying: Have mercy on us, Lord, Son of David.

31 And the crowd rebuked them so that they should be silent; but they cried out more, saying: Have mercy on us, Lord, Son of David.

32 And Jesus stood and called them and said: What do you wish me to do for you?

33 They say to him: Lord, that our eyes may be opened.

34 And Jesus had compassion and touched their eyes, and immediately their eyes saw again, and they followed him.

Chapter 21

1 And when they drew near to Jerusalem and came to Bethphage, toward the mountain of Olives, then Jesus sent two disciples,

2 saying to them: Go into the village opposite you, and immediately you shall find a donkey bound and a colt with her; loose them and bring them to me.

3 And if anyone says anything to you, you shall say: Their Lord has need of them; and immediately he shall send them.

4 And this whole thing has happened so that what was spoken through the prophet might be fulfilled, saying:

5 Say to the daughter of Zion: Behold, your king comes to you, meek and mounted upon a donkey and a colt, the son of a beast of burden.

6 And the disciples went and did as Jesus commanded them,

7 and brought the donkey and the colt, and laid their garments upon them, and he sat upon them.

8 And the very great crowd spread their own garments in the road, and others were cutting branches from the trees and spreading them in the road.

9 And the crowds going before and those following were crying out, saying: Hosanna to the Son of David! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!

10 And when he entered Jerusalem, the whole city was shaken, saying: Who is this?

11 And the crowds were saying: This is Jesus the prophet, the one from Nazareth of Galilee.

12 And Jesus entered into the temple of God and cast out all those selling and buying in the temple, and overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those selling the doves.

13 And he says to them: It is written: My house shall be called a house of prayer; but you made it a cave of robbers.

14 And blind and lame people approached him in the temple, and he healed them.

15 But the chief priests and the scribes, seeing the wonderful things he did and the children crying out in the temple and saying: Hosanna to the Son of David, were indignant,

16 and said to him: Do you hear what these say? And Jesus says to them: Yes; have you never read that out of the mouth of infants and nursing children you prepared praise?

17 And leaving them, he went out of the city to Bethany and lodged there.

18 And in the morning, returning to the city, he was hungry.

19 And seeing one fig tree upon the road, he came to it and found nothing on it except leaves only, and says to it: Let fruit no longer come from you forever. And immediately the fig tree withered.

20 And seeing, the disciples marveled, saying: How did the fig tree wither immediately?

21 And Jesus answered and said to them: Amen, I say to you: If you have faith and do not doubt, you shall do not only the thing of the fig tree, but even if you say to this mountain: Be lifted and cast into the sea, it shall happen.

22 And all things, whatever you ask in prayer, believing, you shall receive.

23 And when he came into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people approached him as he taught, saying: By what authority do you do these things? And who gave you this authority?

24 And Jesus answered and said to them: I also shall ask you one word, which, if you tell me, I also shall tell you by what authority I do these things.

25 The baptism of John, from where was it? From heaven or from men? And they were reasoning among themselves, saying: If we say: From heaven, he shall say to us: Why, then, did you not believe him?

26 But if we say: From men, we fear the crowd, for all hold John as a prophet.

27 And answering Jesus, they said: We do not know. He also said to them: Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.

28 But what do you think? A man had two children, and approaching the first, he said: Child, go, work today in my vineyard.

29 And he answered and said: I do not wish to. But afterward he regretted it and went.

30 And approaching the second, he said likewise. And he answered and said: I, lord; and did not go.

31 Which of the two did the will of the father? They say to him: The first. Jesus says to them: Amen, I say to you that the tax collectors and the prostitutes go before you into the kingdom of God.

32 For John came to you in a way of righteousness, and you did not believe him; but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him. But you, seeing, did not afterward regret it so as to believe him.

33 Hear another parable: There was a certain master of a house who planted a vineyard and put a fence around it and dug a winepress in it and built a tower, and leased it to farmers and went abroad.

34 And when the season of the fruits drew near, he sent his slaves to the farmers to receive his fruits.

35 And the farmers took his slaves, and beat one, and killed another, and stoned another.

36 Again he sent other slaves, more than the first, and they did to them likewise.

37 But afterward he sent his son to them, saying: They shall respect my son.

38 But the farmers, seeing the son, said among themselves: This is the heir; come, let us kill him and take possession of his inheritance.

39 And taking him, they cast him outside the vineyard and killed him.

40 Therefore, when the lord of the vineyard comes, what shall he do to those farmers?

41 They say to him: He shall destroy those evil men evilly, and shall lease the vineyard to other farmers, who shall repay him the fruits in their seasons.

42 Jesus says to them: Have you never read in the Scriptures: The stone which the builders rejected, this became the head of the corner; this came from the Lord, and it is marvelous in our eyes?

43 For this reason I say to you that the kingdom of God shall be taken from you and given to a nation producing its fruits.

44 And he who falls upon this stone shall be shattered, but upon whomever it falls, it shall crush him.

45 And the chief priests and the Pharisees, hearing his parables, knew that he speaks concerning them.

46 And seeking to seize him, they feared the crowds, since they held him as a prophet.

Chapter 22

1 And Jesus answered and again spoke to them in parables, saying:

2 The kingdom of the heavens was likened to a king who made a wedding feast for his son,

3 and sent his slaves to call those invited to the wedding feast, and they were unwilling to come.

4 Again he sent other slaves, saying: Tell those invited: Behold, I prepared my meal; my bulls and the fattened beasts are slaughtered, and everything is ready; come to the wedding feast.

5 But they disregarded it and went away, one to his own field, another to his trade.

6 And the rest seized his slaves and mistreated and killed them.

7 And the king heard and became angry, and sending his armies, he destroyed those murderers and burned their city.

8 Then he says to his slaves: The wedding feast indeed is ready, but those invited were not worthy.

9 Therefore go to the outlets of the roads, and as many as you find, invite to the wedding feast.

10 And those slaves went out into the roads and gathered all whom they found, both evil and good, and the wedding feast was filled with those reclining.

11 And the king entered to look upon those reclining and saw there a man not clothed in a wedding garment.

12 And he says to him: Friend, how did you enter here without having a wedding garment? And he was silenced.

13 Then the king said to the servants: Bind his feet and hands, take him away and cast him into the outer darkness. There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth.

14 For many are called, but few chosen.

15 Then the Pharisees went and took counsel so that they might trap him in a word.

16 And they send their disciples to him with the Herodians, saying: Teacher, we know that you are true and teach the way of God in truth, and you care concerning no one, for you do not look upon the face of men.

17 Tell us, therefore, what you think: Is it lawful to give tax to Caesar or not?

18 And Jesus knew their wickedness and said: Why do you test me, hypocrites?

19 Show me the coin of the tax. And they brought him a denarius.

20 And he says to them: Whose is this image and the inscription?

21 They say to him: Caesar's. Then he says to them: Therefore repay the things of Caesar to Caesar, and the things of God to God.

22 And hearing, they marveled, and leaving him, they went away.

23 On that day Sadducees approached him, who say there is no resurrection, and questioned him,

24 saying: Teacher, Moses said: If anyone dies without having children, his brother shall marry his wife and raise up seed for his brother.

25 And there were seven brothers among us, and the first married and died, and having no seed, left his wife to his brother.

26 Likewise also the second and the third, until the seven.

27 And last of all the woman also died.

28 In the resurrection, therefore, whose wife of the seven shall she be? For all had her.

29 And Jesus answered and said to them: You wander, not knowing the Scriptures nor the power of God.

30 For in the resurrection they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are like angels of God in heaven.

31 But concerning the resurrection of the dead, have you not read what was spoken to you by God, saying:

32 I am the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob? God is not God of the dead, but of the living.

33 And hearing, the crowds were astonished at his teaching.

34 And the Pharisees, hearing that he silenced the Sadducees, gathered together.

35 And one of them, a lawyer, questioned him, testing him and saying:

36 Teacher, which commandment is great in the law?

37 And Jesus said to him: You shall love the Lord your God with your whole heart and with your whole soul and with your whole mind.

38 This is the first and great commandment.

39 And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself.

40 On these two commandments hang the whole law and the prophets.

41 And while the Pharisees were gathered, Jesus questioned them,

42 saying: What do you think concerning the Christ? Whose son is he? They say to him: David's.

43 He says to them: How, then, does David in spirit call him Lord, saying:

44 The Lord said to my Lord: Sit at my right until I place your enemies as a footstool of your feet?

45 If, therefore, David calls him Lord, how is he his son?

46 And no one was able to answer him a word, nor did anyone dare from that day to question him any longer.

Chapter 23

1 Then Jesus spoke to the crowds and to his disciples,

2 saying: The scribes and the Pharisees sat upon the seat of Moses.

3 Therefore everything, whatever they tell you to keep, keep and do; but do not do according to their works, for they say and do not do.

4 For they bind heavy burdens and hard to bear, and lay them upon the shoulders of men, but with their finger they are unwilling to move them.

5 And all their works they do to be seen by men; and they broaden their phylacteries and enlarge the fringes of their garments.

6 And they love the first reclining place at the suppers and the first seats in the synagogues,

7 and the greetings in the marketplaces, and to be called by men: Rabbi, Rabbi.

8 But you, do not be called Rabbi, for one is your guide, the Christ, and you are all brothers.

9 And do not call anyone your father upon the earth, for one is your Father, the one in the heavens.

10 Nor be called guides, for one is your guide, the Christ.

11 But the greater of you shall be your servant.

12 And whoever exalts himself shall be humbled, and whoever humbles himself shall be exalted.

13 But woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you devour the houses of the widows, and with a pretext pray long; for this reason you shall receive greater judgment.

14 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you shut the kingdom of the heavens before men; for you do not enter, nor do you allow those entering to enter.

15 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you go around the sea and the dry land to make one proselyte, and when he becomes one, you make him a son of Gehenna twice as much as you.

16 Woe to you, blind guides, who say: Whoever swears by the sanctuary, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gold of the sanctuary is obligated.

17 Fools and blind men! For which is greater, the gold or the sanctuary sanctifying the gold?

18 And: Whoever swears by the altar, it is nothing; but whoever swears by the gift upon it is obligated.

19 Fools and blind men! For which is greater, the gift or the altar sanctifying the gift?

20 Therefore he who swears by the altar swears by it and by all the things upon it.

21 And he who swears by the sanctuary swears by it and by the one dwelling in it.

22 And he who swears by the heaven swears by the throne of God and by the one sitting upon it.

23 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you tithe the mint and the dill and the cumin, and left the weightier things of the law: judgment and mercy and faith. These you ought to have done, and not leave those.

24 Blind guides, straining out the gnat but swallowing the camel!

25 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you cleanse the outside of the cup and the dish, but inside they are full from plunder and lack of self-control.

26 Blind Pharisee, cleanse first the inside of the cup and the dish, so that their outside also may become clean.

27 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you resemble whitewashed tombs, which indeed appear beautiful outside, but inside are full of bones of the dead and all uncleanness.

28 So also you indeed appear righteous to men outside, but inside you are full of hypocrisy and lawlessness.

29 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you build the tombs of the prophets and adorn the monuments of the righteous,

30 and say: If we had been in the days of our fathers, we would not have been their partners in the blood of the prophets.

31 So that you testify to yourselves that you are sons of those who murdered the prophets.

32 And you, fill up the measure of your fathers.

33 Serpents, offspring of vipers, how shall you flee from the judgment of Gehenna?

34 For this reason, behold, I send to you prophets and wise men and scribes, and some of them you shall kill and crucify, and some of them you shall scourge in your synagogues and persecute from city to city,

35 so that upon you may come all righteous blood poured out upon the earth, from the blood of righteous Abel until the blood of Zechariah son of Barachiah, whom you murdered between the sanctuary and the altar.

36 Amen, I say to you: All these things shall come upon this generation.

37 Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those sent to her, how often I wished to gather your children together in the manner that a hen gathers her chicks together under her wings, and you were unwilling!

38 Behold, your house is left to you deserted.

39 For I say to you: You shall certainly not see me from now until you say: Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.

Chapter 24

1 And Jesus went out and was going away from the temple, and his disciples approached to show him the buildings of the temple.

2 And Jesus said to them: Do you not see all these things? Amen, I say to you: There shall certainly not be left here a stone upon a stone which shall certainly not be demolished.

3 And while he sat upon the mountain of Olives, the disciples approached him privately, saying: Tell us, when shall these things be, and what is the sign of your coming and of the completion of the age?

4 And Jesus answered and said to them: See that no one leads you astray.

5 For many shall come in my name, saying: I am the Christ, and shall lead many astray.

6 And you shall be about to hear wars and reports of wars; see that you are not alarmed, for all must happen, but the end is not yet.

7 For nation shall rise against nation and kingdom against kingdom, and there shall be famines and pestilences and earthquakes in places.

8 And all these things are the beginning of birth pains.

9 Then they shall hand you over to affliction and shall kill you, and you shall be hated by all the nations because of my name.

10 And then many shall be made to stumble, and shall hand one another over and hate one another.

11 And many false prophets shall rise and shall lead many astray.

12 And because lawlessness is multiplied, the love of the many shall grow cold.

13 But he who endures until the end, this one shall be saved.

14 And this good news of the kingdom shall be proclaimed in the whole inhabited world as a testimony to all the nations, and then the end shall come.

15 Therefore, when you see the abomination of desolation, spoken of through Daniel the prophet, standing in a holy place, let the reader perceive,

16 then let those in Judea flee to the mountains.

17 Let the one upon the roof not descend to take anything out of his house.

18 And let the one in the field not turn back to take his garments.

19 And woe to those having in the womb and those nursing in those days!

20 And pray that your flight may not happen in winter nor on a Sabbath.

21 For then there shall be great affliction, such as has not happened from the beginning of the world until now, nor shall certainly happen.

22 And unless those days were shortened, no flesh would be saved; but because of the chosen, those days shall be shortened.

23 Then if anyone says to you: Behold, here is the Christ, or: Here, do not believe.

24 For false christs and false prophets shall rise and shall give great signs and wonders, so as to lead astray, if possible, even the chosen.

25 Behold, I have told you beforehand.

26 Therefore, if they say to you: Behold, he is in the desert, do not go out; behold, in the inner rooms, do not believe.

27 For just as the lightning comes out from the east and appears until the west, so also shall be the coming of the Son of man.

28 For wherever the corpse may be, there the eagles shall be gathered.

29 And immediately after the affliction of those days the sun shall be darkened, and the moon shall not give its light, and the stars shall fall from the heaven, and the powers of the heavens shall be shaken.

30 And then the sign of the Son of man shall appear in the heaven, and then all the tribes of the earth shall mourn, and they shall see the Son of man coming upon the clouds of the heaven with power and much glory.

31 And he shall send his angels with a trumpet of a great voice, and they shall gather his chosen together from the four winds, from the extremities of the heavens until their extremities.

32 And learn the parable from the fig tree: When its branch already becomes tender and puts forth the leaves, you know that summer is near.

33 So also you, when you see all these things, know that it is near, at the doors.

34 Amen, I say to you: This generation shall certainly not pass until all these things happen.

35 The heaven and the earth shall pass away, but my words shall certainly not pass away.

36 But concerning that day and the hour no one knows, not even the angels of the heavens, except my Father alone.

37 And just as the days of Noah, so also shall be the coming of the Son of man.

38 For just as they were in the days before the flood, eating and drinking, marrying and giving in marriage, until the day on which Noah entered into the ark,

39 and did not know until the flood came and took all away, so also shall be the coming of the Son of man.

40 Then two shall be in the field; the one is taken along and the one is left.

41 Two women grinding at the mill; one is taken along and one is left.

42 Therefore keep watch, because you do not know at what hour your Lord comes.

43 But know this, that if the master of the house had known in which watch the thief comes, he would have kept watch and would not have allowed his house to be dug through.

44 For this reason you also become ready, because at an hour you do not think, the Son of man comes.

45 Who, then, is the faithful and prudent slave whom his lord appointed over his household to give them food in season?

46 Blessed is that slave whom his lord, coming, shall find doing so.

47 Amen, I say to you that he shall appoint him over all his possessions.

48 But if that evil slave says in his heart: My lord delays to come,

49 and begins to beat the fellow slaves, and to eat and drink with those who are drunk,

50 the lord of that slave shall come on a day which he does not expect and at an hour which he does not know,

51 and shall cut him in two and place his portion with the hypocrites. There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth.

Chapter 25

1 Then the kingdom of the heavens shall be likened to ten virgins who took their lamps and went out to meet the bridegroom.

2 And five of them were prudent, and the five foolish.

3 Those who were foolish took their own lamps and did not take oil with themselves.

4 But the prudent took oil in their vessels with their lamps.

5 And while the bridegroom delayed, all grew drowsy and slept.

6 And in the middle of the night a cry has arisen: Behold, the bridegroom comes; go out to meet him.

7 Then all those virgins rose and put their lamps in order.

8 And the foolish said to the prudent: Give us from your oil, because our lamps are going out.

9 But the prudent answered, saying: Lest it not suffice for us and you; go rather to those selling and buy for yourselves.

10 And while they were going away to buy, the bridegroom came, and those ready entered with him into the wedding feast, and the door was shut.

11 And afterward the remaining virgins also come, saying: Lord, Lord, open to us.

12 But he answered and said: Amen, I say to you: I do not know you.

13 Therefore keep watch, because you do not know the day nor the hour in which the Son of man comes.

14 For just as a man going abroad called his own slaves and handed his possessions over to them,

15 and to one he gave five talents, and to another two, and to another one, to each according to his own ability, and immediately went abroad.

16 And the one who received the five talents went and worked with them and made another five talents.

17 Likewise also the one with the two, he also gained another two.

18 But the one who received the one went away and dug in the earth and hid his lord's silver.

19 And after much time the lord of those slaves comes and settles an account with them.

20 And the one who received the five talents approached and brought another five talents, saying: Lord, you handed over five talents to me; see, I gained another five talents upon them.

21 And his lord said to him: Well, good and faithful slave; over few things you were faithful, over many I shall appoint you. Enter into the joy of your lord.

22 And the one who received the two talents also approached and said: Lord, you handed over two talents to me; see, I gained another two talents upon them.

23 His lord said to him: Well, good and faithful slave; over few things you were faithful, over many I shall appoint you. Enter into the joy of your lord.

24 And the one who had received the one talent also approached and said: Lord, I knew you, that you are a hard man, harvesting where you did not sow and gathering from where you did not scatter.

25 And fearing, I went away and hid your talent in the earth; see, you have what is yours.

26 And his lord answered and said to him: Evil and lazy slave, you knew that I harvest where I did not sow and gather from where I did not scatter.

27 Therefore you ought to have put my silver with the bankers, and coming, I would have received what is mine with interest.

28 Therefore take the talent from him and give it to the one having the ten talents.

29 For to everyone who has it shall be given, and he shall have abundance; but from the one who does not have, even what he has shall be taken from him.

30 And cast the useless slave into the outer darkness. There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth.

31 And when the Son of man comes in his glory and all the holy angels with him, then he shall sit upon his throne of glory.

32 And all the nations shall be gathered before him, and he shall separate them from one another, just as the shepherd separates the sheep from the goats.

33 And he shall stand the sheep at his right, but the little goats at the left.

34 Then the king shall say to those at his right: Come, those blessed by my Father, inherit the kingdom prepared for you from the foundation of the world.

35 For I was hungry and you gave me to eat; I thirsted and you gave me to drink; I was a stranger and you gathered me in;

36 naked and you clothed me; I was sick and you visited me; I was in prison and you came to me.

37 Then the righteous shall answer him, saying: Lord, when did we see you hungry and feed you, or thirsting and give you to drink?

38 And when did we see you a stranger and gather you in, or naked and clothe you?

39 And when did we see you sick or in prison and come to you?

40 And the king shall answer and say to them: Amen, I say to you: Insofar as you did it to one of these least brothers of mine, you did it to me.

41 Then he shall also say to those at the left: Go from me, those cursed, into the eternal fire prepared for the devil and his angels.

42 For I was hungry and you did not give me to eat; I thirsted and you did not give me to drink;

43 I was a stranger and you did not gather me in; naked and you did not clothe me; sick and in prison and you did not visit me.

44 Then they also shall answer him, saying: Lord, when did we see you hungry or thirsting or a stranger or naked or sick or in prison, and did not serve you?

45 Then he shall answer them, saying: Amen, I say to you: Insofar as you did not do it to one of these least, neither did you do it to me.

46 And these shall go away into eternal punishment, but the righteous into eternal life.

Chapter 26

1 And it happened, when Jesus finished all these words, he said to his disciples:

2 You know that after two days the Passover takes place, and the Son of man is handed over to be crucified.

3 Then the chief priests and the scribes and the elders of the people gathered into the courtyard of the high priest called Caiaphas,

4 and took counsel so that they might seize Jesus by deceit and kill him.

5 But they were saying: Not during the feast, so that an uproar may not arise among the people.

6 And while Jesus was in Bethany in the house of Simon the leper,

7 a woman approached him, having an alabaster vessel of very costly ointment, and poured it upon his head as he reclined.

8 But his disciples, seeing, were indignant, saying: Why this waste?

9 For this ointment could have been sold for much and given to the poor.

10 And Jesus knew and said to them: Why do you give troubles to the woman? For she worked a good work toward me.

11 For you always have the poor with yourselves, but you do not always have me.

12 For she, in putting this ointment upon my body, did it to bury me.

13 Amen, I say to you: Wherever this good news is proclaimed in the whole world, what she did shall also be spoken of as a memorial of her.

14 Then one of the twelve, called Judas Iscariot, went to the chief priests,

15 and said: What do you wish to give me, and I shall hand him over to you? And they weighed out thirty silver pieces for him.

16 And from then he was seeking an opportunity to hand him over.

17 And on the first day of the unleavened bread, the disciples approached Jesus, saying to him: Where do you wish us to prepare for you to eat the Passover?

18 And he said: Go into the city to a certain man and tell him: The teacher says: My time is near; with you I hold the Passover with my disciples.

19 And the disciples did as Jesus directed them and prepared the Passover.

20 And when evening came, he was reclining with the twelve.

21 And while they were eating, he said: Amen, I say to you that one of you shall hand me over.

22 And being exceedingly grieved, each of them began to say to him: Surely it is not I, Lord?

23 And he answered and said: The one who dipped his hand with me in the dish, this one shall hand me over.

24 The Son of man indeed goes as it is written concerning him, but woe to that man through whom the Son of man is handed over! It was good for him if that man had not been born.

25 And Judas, the one handing him over, answered and said: Surely it is not I, Rabbi? He says to him: You said it.

26 And while they were eating, Jesus took the bread and blessed and broke it and was giving it to the disciples, and said: Take, eat; this is my body.

27 And taking the cup and giving thanks, he gave it to them, saying: Drink from it, all of you.

28 For this is my blood, that of the new covenant, poured out concerning many for forgiveness of sins.

29 But I say to you that I shall certainly not drink from now of this produce of the vine until that day when I drink it new with you in the kingdom of my Father.

30 And having sung a hymn, they went out to the mountain of Olives.

31 Then Jesus says to them: All of you shall be made to stumble at me in this night, for it is written: I shall strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock shall be scattered.

32 But after I am raised, I shall go before you into Galilee.

33 And Peter answered and said to him: Even if all shall be made to stumble at you, I shall never be made to stumble.

34 Jesus said to him: Amen, I say to you that in this night, before a rooster calls, you shall deny me three times.

35 Peter says to him: Even if I must die with you, I shall certainly not deny you. Likewise also all the disciples said.

36 Then Jesus comes with them into a place called Gethsemane and says to the disciples: Sit here until I go and pray there.

37 And taking Peter and the two sons of Zebedee with him, he began to be grieved and distressed.

38 Then he says to them: My soul is exceedingly sorrowful until death; remain here and keep watch with me.

39 And going forward a little, he fell upon his face, praying and saying: My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me; nevertheless, not as I wish, but as you.

40 And he comes to the disciples and finds them sleeping, and says to Peter: So, were you not strong enough to keep watch with me one hour?

41 Keep watch and pray so that you may not enter into temptation; the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh weak.

42 Again, going away a second time, he prayed, saying: My Father, if this cup cannot pass from me unless I drink it, let your will happen.

43 And coming, he finds them sleeping again, for their eyes were weighed down.

44 And leaving them, he went away and again prayed a third time, saying the same word.

45 Then he comes to his disciples and says to them: Sleep the rest and take your rest; behold, the hour has drawn near, and the Son of man is handed over into the hands of sinners.

46 Rise, let us go; behold, the one handing me over has drawn near.

47 And while he was still speaking, behold, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great crowd with swords and clubs from the chief priests and elders of the people.

48 And the one handing him over gave them a sign, saying: Whomever I kiss, he is the one; seize him.

49 And immediately approaching Jesus, he said: Greetings, Rabbi; and kissed him fervently.

50 And Jesus said to him: Friend, for what are you here? Then they approached and laid their hands upon Jesus and seized him.

51 And behold, one of those with Jesus stretched out his hand and drew his sword, and striking the slave of the high priest, took off his ear.

52 Then Jesus says to him: Return your sword to its place, for all who take a sword shall perish by a sword.

53 Or do you think that I cannot now appeal to my Father, and he shall provide me more than twelve legions of angels?

54 How, then, should the Scriptures be fulfilled, that it must happen so?

55 In that hour Jesus said to the crowds: As against a robber you came out with swords and clubs to arrest me. Daily I sat with you teaching in the temple, and you did not seize me.

56 But this whole thing has happened so that the Scriptures of the prophets might be fulfilled. Then all the disciples left him and fled.

57 And those who seized Jesus led him away to Caiaphas the high priest, where the scribes and the elders were gathered.

58 And Peter was following him from afar until the courtyard of the high priest, and entering inside, he was sitting with the attendants to see the end.

59 And the chief priests and the elders and the whole council were seeking false testimony against Jesus so that they might put him to death,

60 and did not find it; and though many false witnesses approached, they did not find it.

61 But afterward two false witnesses approached and said: This man said: I am able to demolish the sanctuary of God and to build it through three days.

62 And the high priest stood up and said to him: Do you answer nothing? What do these testify against you?

63 But Jesus was silent. And the high priest answered and said to him: I adjure you by the living God that you tell us whether you are the Christ, the Son of God.

64 Jesus says to him: You said it. Nevertheless, I say to you: From now you shall see the Son of man sitting at the right of the Power and coming upon the clouds of the heaven.

65 Then the high priest tore his garments, saying: He blasphemed! What further need do we have of witnesses? See, now you heard his blasphemy.

66 What do you think? And they answered and said: He is liable to death.

67 Then they spat into his face and struck him with fists, and others slapped him,

68 saying: Prophesy to us, Christ; who is the one who struck you?

69 And Peter was sitting outside in the courtyard, and one servant girl approached him, saying: You also were with Jesus the Galilean.

70 But he denied before all, saying: I do not know what you say.

71 And when he went out to the gateway, another saw him and says to those there: This man also was with Jesus the Nazarene.

72 And again he denied with an oath: I do not know the man.

73 And after a little while those standing approached and said to Peter: Truly you also are one of them, for even your speech makes you evident.

74 Then he began to curse and swear: I do not know the man. And immediately a rooster called.

75 And Peter remembered the saying of Jesus, who had said to him: Before a rooster calls, you shall deny me three times. And going outside, he wept bitterly.

Chapter 27

1 And when morning came, all the chief priests and the elders of the people took counsel against Jesus so as to put him to death.

2 And binding him, they led him away and handed him over to Pontius Pilate the governor.

3 Then Judas, the one handing him over, seeing that he was condemned, regretted it and returned the thirty silver pieces to the chief priests and the elders,

4 saying: I sinned, handing over innocent blood. And they said: What is that to us? You shall see to it.

5 And throwing the silver pieces in the sanctuary, he withdrew, and going away, he hanged himself.

6 And the chief priests took the silver pieces and said: It is not lawful to put them into the treasury, since it is the price of blood.

7 And taking counsel, they bought with them the potter's field for burial for strangers.

8 Therefore that field was called Field of Blood until today.

9 Then what was spoken through Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled, saying: And they took the thirty silver pieces, the price of the one priced, whom they priced from the sons of Israel,

10 and gave them for the potter's field, as the Lord directed me.

11 And Jesus stood before the governor, and the governor questioned him, saying: Are you the king of the Jews? And Jesus said to him: You say it.

12 And while he was accused by the chief priests and the elders, he answered nothing.

13 Then Pilate says to him: Do you not hear how many things they testify against you?

14 And he did not answer him concerning even one word, so that the governor marveled exceedingly.

15 And at a feast the governor was accustomed to release to the crowd one prisoner whom they wished.

16 And they then had a notable prisoner called Barabbas.

17 Therefore, when they gathered, Pilate said to them: Whom do you wish me to release to you, Barabbas or Jesus called Christ?

18 For he knew that because of envy they handed him over.

19 And while he sat upon the judgment seat, his wife sent to him, saying: Nothing between you and that righteous man, for I suffered many things today in a dream because of him.

20 But the chief priests and the elders persuaded the crowds that they should ask for Barabbas, but destroy Jesus.

21 And the governor answered and said to them: Which of the two do you wish me to release to you? And they said: Barabbas.

22 Pilate says to them: What, then, shall I do with Jesus called Christ? They all say to him: Let him be crucified.

23 And the governor said: For what evil did he do? But they cried out exceedingly, saying: Let him be crucified.

24 And Pilate, seeing that he profits nothing, but rather an uproar arises, took water and washed his hands before the crowd, saying: I am innocent of the blood of this righteous man; you shall see to it.

25 And all the people answered and said: His blood upon us and upon our children.

26 Then he released Barabbas to them, but scourged Jesus and handed him over to be crucified.

27 Then the soldiers of the governor took Jesus into the praetorium and gathered the whole cohort against him.

28 And stripping him, they put a scarlet cloak around him.

29 And weaving a crown from thorns, they put it upon his head, and a reed in his right hand, and kneeling before him, they were mocking him, saying: Greetings, king of the Jews.

30 And spitting upon him, they took the reed and were striking his head.

31 And when they mocked him, they stripped the cloak from him and clothed him in his garments and led him away to crucify him.

32 And going out, they found a Cyrenian man named Simon; they compelled this man to take up his cross.

33 And coming into a place called Golgotha, which is called Place of a Skull,

34 they gave him vinegar mixed with gall to drink, and tasting it, he was unwilling to drink.

35 And crucifying him, they divided his garments among themselves, casting a lot, so that what was spoken by the prophet might be fulfilled: They divided my garments among themselves, and upon my clothing they cast a lot.

36 And sitting, they were guarding him there.

37 And they placed above his head his accusation, written: This is Jesus the king of the Jews.

38 Then two robbers are crucified with him, one at the right and one at the left.

39 And those passing by were blaspheming him, moving their heads,

40 and saying: You who demolish the sanctuary and build it in three days, save yourself; if you are God's Son, descend from the cross.

41 And likewise also the chief priests, mocking with the scribes and elders, were saying:

42 He saved others; he cannot save himself. If he is king of Israel, let him descend now from the cross, and we shall believe him.

43 He has trusted in God; let him rescue him now, if he wants him, for he said: I am God's Son.

44 And the robbers crucified with him were also reproaching him with the same thing.

45 And from the sixth hour darkness came upon the whole earth until the ninth hour.

46 And about the ninth hour Jesus cried out with a great voice, saying: Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? This is: My God, my God, why did you forsake me?

47 And some of those standing there, hearing, were saying: This man calls Elijah.

48 And immediately one of them ran and took a sponge and filled it with vinegar and put it on a reed and was giving him to drink.

49 But the rest were saying: Leave it; let us see whether Elijah comes to save him.

50 And Jesus again cried out with a great voice and released the spirit.

51 And behold, the veil of the sanctuary was torn into two from above until below, and the earth was shaken and the rocks were split,

52 and the tombs were opened, and many bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep were raised,

53 and coming out of the tombs after his resurrection, they entered into the holy city and appeared to many.

54 And the centurion and those with him guarding Jesus, seeing the earthquake and the things that happened, feared exceedingly, saying: Truly this was God's Son.

55 And many women were there, watching from afar, who followed Jesus from Galilee, serving him,

56 among whom was Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of James and Joses and the mother of the sons of Zebedee.

57 And when evening came, a rich man from Arimathea came, named Joseph, who himself also became a disciple of Jesus.

58 This man approached Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be given back.

59 And Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth,

60 and put it in his new tomb, which he hewed in the rock, and rolling a great stone to the door of the tomb, he went away.

61 And Mary Magdalene and the other Mary were there, sitting opposite the tomb.

62 And on the next day, which is after the Preparation, the chief priests and the Pharisees gathered to Pilate,

63 saying: Lord, we remembered that that deceiver said while still living: After three days I rise.

64 Therefore command the tomb to be secured until the third day, lest his disciples come by night and steal him and tell the people: He was raised from the dead; and the last deception shall be worse than the first.

65 And Pilate said to them: You have a guard; go, secure it as you know.

66 And they went and secured the tomb, sealing the stone with the guard.

Chapter 28

1 And late on the Sabbath, as it was dawning toward the first day of the week, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary came to look upon the tomb.

2 And behold, a great earthquake happened, for an angel of the Lord descended from heaven and approached and rolled the stone away from the door, and was sitting upon it.

3 And his appearance was like lightning, and his garment white as snow.

4 And from fear of him those guarding were shaken and became like dead men.

5 And the angel answered and said to the women: Do not fear, you; for I know that you seek Jesus who has been crucified.

6 He is not here, for he was raised as he said; come, see the place where the Lord lay.

7 And go quickly and tell his disciples that he was raised from the dead, and behold, he goes before you into Galilee; there you shall see him. Behold, I told you.

8 And going out quickly from the tomb with fear and great joy, they ran to report to his disciples.

9 And as they were going to report to his disciples, behold, Jesus met them, saying: Rejoice. And they approached and took hold of his feet and worshiped him.

10 Then Jesus says to them: Do not fear; go, report to my brothers that they should go away into Galilee, and there they shall see me.

11 And while they were going, behold, some of the guard came into the city and reported to the chief priests all the things that happened.

12 And gathering with the elders and taking counsel, they gave sufficient silver pieces to the soldiers,

13 saying: Say that his disciples came by night and stole him while we slept.

14 And if this is heard before the governor, we shall persuade him and make you free from care.

15 And they took the silver pieces and did as they were taught; and this word was spread abroad among Jews until today.

16 And the eleven disciples went into Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus appointed them.

17 And seeing him, they worshiped him; but some doubted.

18 And Jesus approached and spoke to them, saying: All authority was given to me in heaven and upon earth.

19 Therefore go and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them into the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,

20 teaching them to keep everything, whatever I commanded you; and behold, I am with you all the days until the completion of the age. Amen.

Mark

Chapter 1

1 Beginning of the good news of Jesus Christ, Son of God.

2 As it is written in the prophets: Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who shall prepare your way before you.

3 A voice of one crying in the desert: Prepare the way of the Lord; make his paths straight.

4 John came, baptizing in the desert and proclaiming a baptism of repentance for forgiveness of sins.

5 And the whole Judean region and the Jerusalemites were going out to him, and all were being baptized by him in the Jordan river, confessing their sins.

6 And John was clothed in camel's hair and a leather belt around his waist, and eating locusts and wild honey.

7 And he was proclaiming, saying: The one stronger than I comes behind me, whose strap of his sandals I am not sufficient to stoop and loose.

8 I indeed baptized you in water, but he shall baptize you in the Holy Spirit.

9 And it happened in those days, Jesus came from Nazareth of Galilee and was baptized by John into the Jordan.

10 And immediately, coming up from the water, he saw the heavens being torn and the Spirit like a dove descending upon him.

11 And a voice came from the heavens: You are my beloved Son, in whom I was well pleased.

12 And immediately the Spirit drives him out into the desert.

13 And he was there in the desert forty days, being tempted by Satan, and was with the wild beasts, and the angels were serving him.

14 And after John was handed over, Jesus came into Galilee, proclaiming the good news of the kingdom of God,

15 and saying: The time has been fulfilled, and the kingdom of God has drawn near; repent and believe in the good news.

16 And walking beside the sea of Galilee, he saw Simon and Andrew his brother casting a casting net in the sea, for they were fishermen.

17 And Jesus said to them: Come behind me, and I shall make you become fishers of men.

18 And immediately leaving their nets, they followed him.

19 And going forward a little from there, he saw James the son of Zebedee and John his brother, and they were in the boat mending the nets.

20 And immediately he called them, and leaving their father Zebedee in the boat with the hired men, they went away behind him.

21 And they enter into Capernaum, and immediately on the Sabbath he entered into the synagogue and was teaching.

22 And they were astonished at his teaching, for he was teaching them as one having authority, and not as the scribes.

23 And in their synagogue there was a man in an unclean spirit, and he cried out,

24 saying: Ah! What is between us and you, Jesus the Nazarene? Did you come to destroy us? I know you, who you are: the Holy One of God.

25 And Jesus rebuked him, saying: Be silenced, and come out of him.

26 And the unclean spirit convulsed him and cried with a great voice and came out of him.

27 And all were amazed, so that they debated among themselves, saying: What is this? What is this new teaching, that with authority he commands even the unclean spirits, and they obey him?

28 And his report immediately went out into the whole surrounding region of Galilee.

29 And immediately going out from the synagogue, they came into the house of Simon and Andrew with James and John.

30 And Simon's mother-in-law lay sick with a fever, and immediately they tell him concerning her.

31 And approaching, he raised her, taking hold of her hand, and the fever left her immediately, and she was serving them.

32 And when evening came, when the sun set, they were bringing to him all who were ill and those demon-possessed.

33 And the whole city was gathered together at the door.

34 And he healed many who were ill with various diseases and cast out many demons, and did not allow the demons to speak, because they knew him.

35 And early, while it was very much night, he rose and went out and went away into a deserted place, and there he was praying.

36 And Simon and those with him pursued him,

37 and finding him, they say to him: All seek you.

38 And he says to them: Let us go into the neighboring village towns, so that I may proclaim there also, for to this end I have come out.

39 And he was proclaiming in their synagogues throughout all Galilee and casting out the demons.

40 And a leper comes to him, begging him and kneeling to him and saying to him: If you wish, you are able to cleanse me.

41 And Jesus had compassion and stretched out his hand and touched him, and says to him: I wish; be cleansed.

42 And when he spoke, immediately the leprosy went away from him, and he was cleansed.

43 And sternly admonishing him, immediately he sent him out,

44 and says to him: See that you say nothing to anyone, but go, show yourself to the priest and offer concerning your cleansing what Moses commanded, as a testimony to them.

45 But he went out and began to proclaim much and spread the word abroad, so that he could no longer openly enter into a city, but was outside in deserted places, and they were coming to him from everywhere.

Chapter 2

1 And again he entered into Capernaum after some days, and it was heard that he is in a house.

2 And immediately many gathered, so that there was no longer room, not even at the door, and he was speaking the word to them.

3 And they come to him, bringing a paralytic, carried by four.

4 And being unable to draw near to him because of the crowd, they unroofed the roof where he was, and digging through, they lower the pallet upon which the paralytic lay.

5 And Jesus, seeing their faith, says to the paralytic: Child, your sins have been forgiven you.

6 And some of the scribes were sitting there and reasoning in their hearts:

7 Why does this man speak blasphemies so? Who is able to forgive sins except one, God?

8 And immediately Jesus, recognizing in his spirit that they reason so among themselves, said to them: Why do you reason these things in your hearts?

9 Which is easier, to say to the paralytic: Your sins have been forgiven you, or to say: Rise and take up your pallet and walk?

10 But so that you may know that the Son of man has authority to forgive sins upon the earth, he says to the paralytic:

11 I say to you: Rise and take up your pallet and go into your house.

12 And he rose immediately and took up the pallet and went out before all, so that all were astonished and glorified God, saying: We never saw so.

13 And he went out again beside the sea, and the whole crowd was coming to him, and he was teaching them.

14 And passing by, he saw Levi the son of Alphaeus sitting at the tax office, and says to him: Follow me. And rising, he followed him.

15 And it happened, while he reclined in his house, many tax collectors and sinners also reclined with Jesus and his disciples, for they were many and followed him.

16 And the scribes and the Pharisees, seeing him eating with the tax collectors and sinners, were saying to his disciples: Why is it that he eats and drinks with the tax collectors and sinners?

17 And hearing, Jesus says to them: Those who are strong have no need of a physician, but those who are ill. I did not come to call righteous men, but sinners to repentance.

18 And John's disciples and those of the Pharisees were fasting, and they come and say to him: Why do John's disciples and those of the Pharisees fast, but your disciples do not fast?

19 And Jesus said to them: Can the sons of the bridal chamber fast while the bridegroom is with them? As long as they have the bridegroom with themselves, they cannot fast.

20 But days shall come when the bridegroom is taken away from them, and then they shall fast in those days.

21 And no one sews a patch of unfulled cloth upon an old garment; otherwise its filling, the new, takes away from the old, and a worse tear happens.

22 And no one puts new wine into old wineskins; otherwise the new wine bursts the wineskins, and the wine is poured out and the wineskins shall perish; but new wine must be put into fresh wineskins.

23 And it happened that he passed through the grainfields on the Sabbath, and his disciples began to make a way, plucking the ears of grain.

24 And the Pharisees were saying to him: See, why do they do on the Sabbath what is not lawful?

25 And he was saying to them: Have you never read what David did when he had need and was hungry, he and those with him,

26 how he entered into the house of God in the time of Abiathar the high priest, and ate the loaves of the presentation, which it is not lawful to eat except for the priests, and also gave to those who were with him?

27 And he was saying to them: The Sabbath came into being because of man, not man because of the Sabbath.

28 So that the Son of man is Lord also of the Sabbath.

Chapter 3

1 And he entered again into the synagogue, and a man was there having his hand withered.

2 And they were watching him, whether he would heal him on the Sabbath, so that they might accuse him.

3 And he says to the man having the withered hand: Rise into the midst.

4 And he says to them: Is it lawful on the Sabbath to do good or to do evil, to save a soul or to kill? But they were silent.

5 And looking around at them with anger, grieving at the hardening of their heart, he says to the man: Stretch out your hand. And he stretched it out, and his hand was restored healthy as the other.

6 And the Pharisees went out and immediately with the Herodians were taking counsel against him, so that they might destroy him.

7 And Jesus withdrew with his disciples toward the sea, and a great multitude from Galilee followed him, and from Judea,

8 and from Jerusalem and from Idumea and beyond the Jordan, and those around Tyre and Sidon, a great multitude, hearing how many things he was doing, came to him.

9 And he told his disciples that a little boat should remain ready for him because of the crowd, so that they might not press him.

10 For he healed many, so that as many as had afflictions fell upon him to touch him.

11 And the unclean spirits, whenever they saw him, were falling before him and crying out, saying: You are the Son of God.

12 And he was rebuking them much, so that they might not make him manifest.

13 And he goes up into the mountain and calls to him those whom he himself wished, and they went to him.

14 And he made twelve, so that they might be with him and so that he might send them to proclaim,

15 and to have authority to heal the diseases and cast out the demons.

16 And he put upon Simon the name Peter,

17 and James the son of Zebedee and John the brother of James, and he put upon them names, Boanerges, which is: Sons of thunder;

18 and Andrew and Philip and Bartholomew and Matthew and Thomas and James the son of Alphaeus and Thaddaeus and Simon the Cananite,

19 and Judas Iscariot, who also handed him over. And they come into a house.

20 And a crowd comes together again, so that they are not able even to eat bread.

21 And those belonging to him heard and went out to seize him, for they were saying: He is out of his mind.

22 And the scribes who came down from Jerusalem were saying: He has Beelzebul, and: By the ruler of the demons he casts out the demons.

23 And calling them to him, he was saying to them in parables: How can Satan cast out Satan?

24 And if a kingdom is divided against itself, that kingdom cannot stand.

25 And if a house is divided against itself, that house cannot stand.

26 And if Satan rose against himself and has been divided, he cannot stand, but has an end.

27 No one can enter into the house of the strong man and plunder his goods unless he first binds the strong man, and then he shall plunder his house.

28 Amen, I say to you that all sins shall be forgiven the sons of men, and blasphemies, as many as they may blaspheme.

29 But whoever blasphemes against the Holy Spirit has no forgiveness forever, but is liable to eternal judgment.

30 Because they were saying: He has an unclean spirit.

31 Therefore his brothers and his mother come, and standing outside, they sent to him, calling him.

32 And a crowd was sitting around him, and they said to him: Behold, your mother and your brothers outside seek you.

33 And he answered them, saying: Who is my mother or my brothers?

34 And looking around in a circle at those sitting around him, he says: See, my mother and my brothers.

35 For whoever does the will of God, this one is my brother and my sister and mother.

Chapter 4

1 And again he began to teach beside the sea, and a great crowd gathered to him, so that he entered into the boat and sat on the sea, and the whole crowd was upon the earth beside the sea.

2 And he was teaching them many things in parables and was saying to them in his teaching:

3 Hear; behold, the sower went out to sow.

4 And it happened as he sowed, some fell beside the road, and the birds of the heaven came and devoured it.

5 And other fell upon the rocky ground, where it did not have much earth, and immediately sprang up because it had no depth of earth.

6 And when the sun rose, it was scorched, and because it had no root, it withered.

7 And other fell into the thorns, and the thorns grew up and choked it, and it gave no fruit.

8 And other fell into the good earth and was giving fruit, rising and growing, and was bearing, one thirty and one sixty and one a hundred.

9 And he was saying to them: He who has ears to hear, let him hear.

10 And when he was alone, those around him with the twelve asked him about the parable.

11 And he was saying to them: To you it has been given to know the mystery of the kingdom of God, but to those outside all things happen in parables,

12 so that seeing they may see and not perceive, and hearing they may hear and not understand, lest they turn and their sins be forgiven them.

13 And he says to them: Do you not know this parable? And how shall you know all the parables?

14 The sower sows the word.

15 And these are those beside the road where the word is sown, and when they hear, immediately Satan comes and takes away the word sown in their hearts.

16 And these likewise are those sown upon the rocky places, who, when they hear the word, immediately receive it with joy,

17 and have no root in themselves, but are temporary; then, when affliction or persecution arises because of the word, immediately they are made to stumble.

18 And these are those sown into the thorns; these are those hearing the word,

19 and the cares of this age and the deceit of wealth and the desires concerning the remaining things enter in and choke the word, and it becomes unfruitful.

20 And these are those sown upon the good earth, who hear the word and receive it and bear fruit, one thirty and one sixty and one a hundred.

21 And he was saying to them: Does the lamp come so that it may be placed under the bushel or under the bed? Is it not so that it may be placed upon the lampstand?

22 For there is nothing hidden unless it should be manifested, nor did anything become concealed except so that it might come into the open.

23 If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear.

24 And he was saying to them: See what you hear; with the measure with which you measure it shall be measured to you, and it shall be added to you who hear.

25 For whoever has, to him it shall be given, and whoever does not have, even what he has shall be taken from him.

26 And he was saying: So is the kingdom of God, as if a man casts the seed upon the earth,

27 and sleeps and rises night and day, and the seed sprouts and grows long, how he himself does not know.

28 For the earth bears fruit of itself, first a blade, then an ear, then full grain in the ear.

29 And when the fruit yields, immediately he sends the sickle, because the harvest has arrived.

30 And he was saying: To what shall we liken the kingdom of God, or in what parable shall we set it forth?

31 As to a grain of mustard, which, when sown upon the earth, is smaller than all the seeds upon the earth.

32 And when it is sown, it rises and becomes greater than all the garden plants and makes great branches, so that the birds of the heaven can dwell under its shade.

33 And with many such parables he was speaking the word to them, as they were able to hear.

34 But without a parable he was not speaking to them, and privately he was explaining everything to his disciples.

35 And he says to them on that day, when evening came: Let us pass through to the other side.

36 And leaving the crowd, they take him along as he was in the boat, and other little boats also were with him.

37 And a great windstorm arises, and the waves were beating into the boat, so that it was already being filled.

38 And he was in the stern, sleeping upon the cushion, and they wake him and say to him: Teacher, do you not care that we perish?

39 And waking, he rebuked the wind and said to the sea: Be silent; be silenced. And the wind ceased, and a great calm came.

40 And he said to them: Why are you so cowardly? How do you have no faith?

41 And they feared a great fear and were saying to one another: Who, then, is this, that even the wind and the sea obey him?

Chapter 5

1 And they came to the other side of the sea, into the region of the Gadarenes.

2 And when he went out from the boat, immediately a man from the tombs in an unclean spirit met him,

3 who had his dwelling in the tombs, and no one could bind him, not even with chains,

4 because he had often been bound with shackles and chains, and the chains had been torn apart by him and the shackles shattered, and no one was strong enough to tame him.

5 And continually, night and day, in the mountains and in the tombs, he was crying out and cutting himself with stones.

6 And seeing Jesus from afar, he ran and worshiped him,

7 and crying with a great voice, said: What is between me and you, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I adjure you by God, do not torture me.

8 For he was saying to him: Come out of the man, unclean spirit.

9 And he was questioning him: What is your name? And he answered, saying: Legion is my name, because we are many.

10 And he was begging him much that he might not send them outside the region.

11 And there was there by the mountains a great herd of pigs feeding.

12 And all the demons begged him, saying: Send us into the pigs so that we may enter into them.

13 And immediately Jesus permitted them, and the unclean spirits came out and entered into the pigs, and the herd rushed down the precipice into the sea; and they were about two thousand, and were drowning in the sea.

14 And those feeding the pigs fled and reported into the city and into the fields, and they went out to see what has happened.

15 And they come to Jesus and see the demon-possessed man sitting and clothed and in his right mind, the one who had had the legion, and they feared.

16 And those who saw recounted to them how it happened to the demon-possessed man, and concerning the pigs.

17 And they began to beg him to depart from their borders.

18 And when he entered into the boat, the man who had been demon-possessed was begging him that he might be with him.

19 But Jesus did not allow him, but says to him: Go into your house to your own people, and report to them how many things the Lord did for you and had mercy on you.

20 And he went away and began to proclaim in the Decapolis how many things Jesus did for him, and all were marveling.

21 And when Jesus crossed over in the boat again to the other side, a great crowd gathered to him, and he was beside the sea.

22 And behold, one of the synagogue rulers comes, named Jairus, and seeing him, falls at his feet,

23 and was begging him much, saying: My little daughter is at the point of death; that you come and lay your hands upon her, so that she may be saved, and she shall live.

24 And he went away with him, and a great crowd was following him, and they were pressing him together.

25 And a certain woman, being in a flow of blood twelve years,

26 and having suffered many things by many physicians, and having spent everything she had, and having benefited nothing, but rather having come into the worse,

27 heard concerning Jesus and came in the crowd from behind and touched his garment.

28 For she was saying: Even if I touch his garments, I shall be saved.

29 And immediately the fountain of her blood dried up, and she knew in her body that she has been healed from the affliction.

30 And immediately Jesus, recognizing in himself the power which had gone out from him, turned in the crowd and was saying: Who touched my garments?

31 And his disciples were saying to him: You see the crowd pressing you together, and you say: Who touched me?

32 And he was looking around to see the one who did this.

33 And the woman, fearing and trembling, knowing what had happened to her, came and fell before him and told him all the truth.

34 And he said to her: Daughter, your faith has saved you; go into peace, and be healthy from your affliction.

35 While he was still speaking, they come from the synagogue ruler, saying: Your daughter died; why do you still trouble the teacher?

36 And Jesus immediately heard the word being spoken and says to the synagogue ruler: Do not fear; only believe.

37 And he allowed no one to follow together with him except Peter and James and John the brother of James.

38 And he comes into the house of the synagogue ruler and sees an uproar, people weeping and wailing much.

39 And entering, he says to them: Why do you make an uproar and weep? The child did not die, but sleeps.

40 And they were laughing at him. But he cast all out and takes the father of the child and the mother and those with him, and enters where the child was lying.

41 And taking hold of the child's hand, he says to her: Talitha koumi, which is translated: Girl, I say to you, rise.

42 And immediately the girl rose and was walking, for she was twelve years old; and they were astonished with great astonishment.

43 And he charged them much that no one should know this, and said that something should be given her to eat.

Chapter 6

1 And he went out from there and came into his homeland, and his disciples follow him.

2 And when the Sabbath came, he began to teach in the synagogue, and many hearing were astonished, saying: From where does this man have these things? And what is the wisdom given to him, that even such mighty works happen through his hands?

3 Is this not the carpenter, the son of Mary, and brother of James and Joses and Judas and Simon? And are not his sisters here with us? And they were made to stumble at him.

4 And Jesus was saying to them: A prophet is not without honor except in his homeland and among his relatives and in his house.

5 And he could do no mighty work there, except he laid his hands upon a few sick people and healed them.

6 And he was marveling because of their unbelief. And he was going around the villages in a circle, teaching.

7 And he calls the twelve to him and began to send them two by two, and was giving them authority over the unclean spirits.

8 And he commanded them to take nothing for a journey except a staff only, no bag, no bread, no copper in the belt,

9 but to be shod with sandals, and: Do not put on two tunics.

10 And he was saying to them: Wherever you enter into a house, remain there until you go out from there.

11 And as many as do not receive you nor hear you, going out from there, shake off the dust from beneath your feet as a testimony to them. Amen, I say to you: It shall be more bearable for Sodom or Gomorrah on the day of judgment than for that city.

12 And going out, they were proclaiming that they should repent.

13 And they were casting out many demons and anointing many sick people with oil and healing.

14 And king Herod heard, for his name became manifest, and he was saying: John the baptizer was raised from the dead, and for this reason the powers work in him.

15 Others were saying: He is Elijah. And others were saying: He is a prophet, or as one of the prophets.

16 But Herod heard and said: John, whom I beheaded, this is he; he was raised from the dead.

17 For Herod himself sent and seized John and bound him in the prison because of Herodias, the wife of Philip his brother, because he married her.

18 For John was saying to Herod: It is not lawful for you to have your brother's wife.

19 And Herodias held a grudge against him and wished to kill him, and could not.

20 For Herod feared John, knowing him as a righteous and holy man, and was protecting him, and hearing him, he was doing many things and was hearing him gladly.

21 And an opportune day came, when Herod on his birthday was making a supper for his great men and the commanders of thousands and the first men of Galilee,

22 and the daughter of Herodias herself entered and danced and pleased Herod and those reclining with him; the king said to the girl: Ask me whatever you wish, and I shall give it to you.

23 And he swore to her: Whatever you ask me, I shall give you, until half my kingdom.

24 And she went out and said to her mother: What shall I ask? And she said: The head of John the Baptist.

25 And immediately entering with haste to the king, she asked, saying: I wish that you give me at once on a platter the head of John the Baptist.

26 And the king became exceedingly sorrowful, but because of the oaths and those reclining with him, he was unwilling to refuse her.

27 And immediately the king sent an executioner and commanded his head to be brought.

28 And he went away and beheaded him in the prison, and brought his head on a platter and gave it to the girl, and the girl gave it to her mother.

29 And his disciples heard and came and took his corpse and placed it in the tomb.

30 And the apostles gather to Jesus and reported to him everything, both whatever they did and whatever they taught.

31 And he said to them: Come, you yourselves, privately into a deserted place, and rest a little. For those coming and those going were many, and they did not even have opportunity to eat.

32 And they went away into a deserted place by the boat privately.

33 And the crowds saw them going, and many recognized him, and on foot from all the cities they ran together there and went ahead of them and came together to him.

34 And coming out, Jesus saw a great crowd and had compassion on them, because they were like sheep not having a shepherd, and began to teach them many things.

35 And when the hour had already grown late, his disciples approached him and say: The place is deserted, and the hour is already late.

36 Dismiss them so that they may go into the surrounding fields and villages and buy loaves for themselves, for they have nothing to eat.

37 And he answered and said to them: You give them something to eat. And they say to him: Shall we go and buy two hundred denarii of loaves and give them to eat?

38 And he says to them: How many loaves do you have? Go and see. And knowing, they say: Five, and two fish.

39 And he commanded them to make all recline, dining group by dining group, upon the green grass.

40 And they reclined, row by row, by hundreds and by fifties.

41 And taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up into the heaven and blessed and broke the loaves, and was giving them to his disciples so that they might set them before them; and the two fish he divided to all.

42 And all ate and were filled.

43 And they took up twelve baskets full of fragments, and from the fish.

44 And those who ate the loaves were about five thousand men.

45 And immediately he compelled his disciples to enter into the boat and go ahead to the other side toward Bethsaida, until he himself should dismiss the crowd.

46 And taking leave of them, he went away into the mountain to pray.

47 And when evening came, the boat was in the midst of the sea, and he alone upon the earth.

48 And he saw them tormented in rowing, for the wind was contrary to them; and about the fourth watch of the night he comes to them, walking upon the sea, and wished to pass by them.

49 But they, seeing him walking upon the sea, thought it was an apparition, and cried out.

50 For all saw him and were troubled, and immediately he spoke with them and says to them: Take courage; I am; do not fear.

51 And he went up to them into the boat, and the wind ceased; and they were exceedingly beyond measure astonished in themselves and marveling.

52 For they did not understand concerning the loaves, for their heart was hardened.

53 And crossing over, they came upon the land of Gennesaret and moored.

54 And when they went out of the boat, immediately recognizing him,

55 they ran around that whole surrounding region and began to carry around on pallets those who were ill, wherever they heard that he is there.

56 And wherever he entered into villages or cities or fields, they were placing the sick in the marketplaces and begging him that they might touch even the fringe of his garment; and as many as touched him were being saved.

Chapter 7

1 And the Pharisees and some of the scribes, coming from Jerusalem, gather to him.

2 And seeing some of his disciples eating loaves with common hands, that is, unwashed, they found fault.

3 For the Pharisees and all the Jews, unless they wash their hands with a fist, do not eat, holding the tradition of the elders.

4 And from the marketplace, unless they wash themselves, they do not eat; and there are many other things which they received to hold: washings of cups and pitchers and copper vessels and beds.

5 Then the Pharisees and the scribes question him: Why do your disciples not walk according to the tradition of the elders, but eat the bread with unwashed hands?

6 And he answered and said to them: Isaiah prophesied well concerning you hypocrites, as it is written: This people honors me with their lips, but their heart is far from me.

7 And in vain they worship me, teaching teachings, commandments of men.

8 For leaving the commandment of God, you hold the tradition of men, washings of pitchers and cups, and many other such similar things you do.

9 And he was saying to them: Well do you reject the commandment of God so that you may keep your tradition.

10 For Moses said: Honor your father and your mother; and: He who speaks evil of father or mother, let him die by death.

11 But you say: If a man says to his father or mother: Corban, which is a gift, whatever you might benefit from me,

12 and you no longer allow him to do anything for his father or his mother,

13 making the word of God void by your tradition which you handed down; and many such similar things you do.

14 And calling the whole crowd to him, he was saying to them: Hear me, all, and understand.

15 There is nothing from outside the man entering into him which can defile him, but the things coming out from him, those are the things defiling the man.

16 If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear.

17 And when he entered into a house from the crowd, his disciples were questioning him concerning the parable.

18 And he says to them: Are you also so without understanding? Do you not perceive that everything from outside entering into the man cannot defile him,

19 because it does not enter into his heart, but into the belly, and goes out into the latrine, cleansing all the foods?

20 And he was saying: What comes out of the man, that defiles the man.

21 For from within, out of the heart of men, the evil reasonings come out, adulteries, fornications, murders,

22 thefts, greed, wickednesses, deceit, licentiousness, an evil eye, blasphemy, arrogance, foolishness.

23 All these evil things come out from within and defile the man.

24 And rising from there, he went away into the border regions of Tyre and Sidon, and entering into the house, he wished no one to know, and could not remain hidden.

25 For a woman heard concerning him, whose little daughter had an unclean spirit, and came and fell at his feet.

26 And the woman was a Greek, a Syrophoenician by race, and was asking him to cast the demon out of her daughter.

27 But Jesus said to her: Allow the children first to be filled, for it is not good to take the children's bread and cast it to the little dogs.

28 And she answered and says to him: Yes, Lord, for even the little dogs under the table eat from the crumbs of the children.

29 And he said to her: Because of this word, go; the demon has come out of your daughter.

30 And going away into her house, she found the demon gone out and the daughter lying upon the bed.

31 And again going out from the borders of Tyre and Sidon, he came toward the sea of Galilee through the midst of the borders of the Decapolis.

32 And they bring him a deaf man with difficulty speaking, and beg him to lay his hand upon him.

33 And taking him away from the crowd privately, he put his fingers into his ears and spat and touched his tongue.

34 And looking up into the heaven, he sighed and says to him: Ephphatha, which is: Be opened.

35 And immediately his ears were opened, and the bond of his tongue was loosed, and he was speaking correctly.

36 And he charged them to tell no one; but as much as he charged them, they were proclaiming more abundantly.

37 And they were exceedingly beyond measure astonished, saying: He has done all things well; he makes both the deaf hear and the speechless speak.

Chapter 8

1 In those days, there being a very great crowd and having nothing to eat, Jesus called his disciples to him and says to them:

2 I have compassion on the crowd, because already they remain with me three days and have nothing to eat.

3 And if I dismiss them fasting into their house, they shall faint on the road, for some of them have come from afar.

4 And his disciples answered him: From where shall anyone be able to fill these with loaves here in a deserted place?

5 And he was questioning them: How many loaves do you have? And they said: Seven.

6 And he commanded the crowd to recline upon the earth, and taking the seven loaves, he gave thanks and broke them and was giving them to his disciples so that they might set them forth, and they set them before the crowd.

7 And they had a few little fish, and blessing, he said to set those forth also.

8 And they ate and were filled, and took up surpluses of fragments, seven large baskets.

9 And those who ate were about four thousand, and he dismissed them.

10 And immediately entering into the boat with his disciples, he came into the regions of Dalmanutha.

11 And the Pharisees came out and began to debate with him, seeking from him a sign from the heaven, testing him.

12 And sighing deeply in his spirit, he says: Why does this generation seek a sign? Amen, I say to you: If a sign shall be given to this generation!

13 And leaving them, he entered again into the boat and went away to the other side.

14 And they forgot to take loaves, and except for one loaf they had none with themselves in the boat.

15 And he was charging them, saying: See, beware of the leaven of the Pharisees and the leaven of Herod.

16 And they were reasoning with one another, saying: Because we have no loaves.

17 And Jesus knew and says to them: Why do you reason because you have no loaves? Do you not yet perceive nor understand? Do you still have your heart hardened?

18 Having eyes, do you not see? And having ears, do you not hear? And do you not remember,

19 when I broke the five loaves for the five thousand, how many baskets full of fragments you took up? They say to him: Twelve.

20 And when the seven for the four thousand, how many large basketfuls of fragments did you take up? And they said: Seven.

21 And he was saying to them: How do you not understand?

22 And he comes into Bethsaida, and they bring him a blind man and beg him to touch him.

23 And taking hold of the blind man's hand, he brought him outside the village, and spitting into his eyes and laying his hands upon him, he was questioning him whether he sees anything.

24 And looking up, he was saying: I see the men, because I behold them like trees walking.

25 Then again he laid his hands upon his eyes and made him look up, and he was restored and looked clearly upon all.

26 And he sent him into his house, saying: Neither enter into the village nor tell anyone in the village.

27 And Jesus and his disciples went out into the villages of Caesarea Philippi, and on the road he was questioning his disciples, saying to them: Who do men say that I am?

28 And they answered: John the Baptist; and others Elijah; and others one of the prophets.

29 And he says to them: But you, who do you say that I am? And Peter answered and says to him: You are the Christ.

30 And he rebuked them so that they should tell no one concerning him.

31 And he began to teach them that the Son of man must suffer many things and be rejected by the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and after three days rise.

32 And he was speaking the word openly. And Peter took him aside and began to rebuke him.

33 But he turned and saw his disciples and rebuked Peter, saying: Go behind me, Satan, because you do not mind the things of God, but the things of men.

34 And calling the crowd to him with his disciples, he said to them: Whoever wishes to come behind me, let him deny himself and take up his cross and follow me.

35 For whoever wishes to save his soul shall lose it, but whoever loses his soul because of me and the good news, this one shall save it.

36 For what shall it profit a man if he gains the whole world and suffers the loss of his soul?

37 Or what shall a man give in exchange for his soul?

38 For whoever is ashamed of me and my words in this adulterous and sinful generation, the Son of man also shall be ashamed of him when he comes in the glory of his Father with the holy angels.

Chapter 9

1 And he was saying to them: Amen, I say to you that there are some of those standing here who shall certainly not taste death until they see the kingdom of God having come in power.

2 And after six days Jesus takes Peter and James and John with him, and brings them up into a high mountain privately, alone, and he was transfigured before them.

3 And his garments became shining, exceedingly white as snow, such as a fuller upon the earth cannot whiten.

4 And Elijah with Moses appeared to them, and they were conversing with Jesus.

5 And Peter answered and says to Jesus: Rabbi, it is good for us to be here, and let us make three tents, one for you and one for Moses and one for Elijah.

6 For he did not know what to speak, for they were terrified.

7 And a cloud came, overshadowing them, and a voice came from the cloud, saying: This is my beloved Son; hear him.

8 And suddenly looking around, they no longer saw anyone, but Jesus alone with themselves.

9 And as they descended from the mountain, he charged them to recount to no one what they saw, except when the Son of man rises from the dead.

10 And they held the word to themselves, debating what rising from the dead is.

11 And they were questioning him, saying: Why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?

12 And he answered and said to them: Elijah indeed comes first and restores all things; and how is it written concerning the Son of man, that he should suffer many things and be treated as nothing?

13 But I say to you that Elijah also has come, and they did to him whatever they wished, as it is written concerning him.

14 And coming to the disciples, he saw a great crowd around them and scribes debating with them.

15 And immediately the whole crowd, seeing him, was greatly amazed, and running to him, they were greeting him.

16 And he questioned the scribes: What do you debate with them?

17 And one from the crowd answered and said: Teacher, I brought my son to you, having a speechless spirit.

18 And wherever it seizes him, it throws him down, and he foams and grinds his teeth and withers; and I told your disciples to cast it out, and they were not strong enough.

19 And he answered him and says: O unbelieving generation, until when shall I be with you? Until when shall I bear with you? Bring him to me.

20 And they brought him to him; and seeing him, immediately the spirit convulsed him, and falling upon the earth, he was rolling, foaming.

21 And he questioned his father: How much time is it since this has happened to him? And he said: From childhood.

22 And often it cast him both into fire and into waters to destroy him; but if you are able to do anything, help us, having compassion on us.

23 And Jesus said to him: If you are able to believe; all things are possible for the one who believes.

24 And immediately the father of the child cried out with tears and was saying: I believe, Lord; help my unbelief.

25 And Jesus, seeing that a crowd runs together, rebuked the unclean spirit, saying to it: Speechless and deaf spirit, I command you, come out of him and no longer enter into him.

26 And crying out and convulsing him much, it came out, and he became like a dead man, so that many said: He died.

27 But Jesus took hold of him by the hand and raised him, and he rose.

28 And when he entered into a house, his disciples were questioning him privately: Why were we not able to cast it out?

29 And he said to them: This kind can come out by nothing except by prayer and fasting.

30 And going out from there, they were passing through Galilee, and he did not wish anyone to know.

31 For he was teaching his disciples and was saying to them: The Son of man is handed over into the hands of men, and they shall kill him, and being killed, on the third day he shall rise.

32 But they did not understand the saying and feared to question him.

33 And he came into Capernaum, and being in the house, he was questioning them: What were you reasoning among yourselves on the road?

34 But they were silent, for they discussed with one another on the road who was greater.

35 And sitting down, he called the twelve and says to them: If anyone wishes to be first, he shall be last of all and servant of all.

36 And taking a child, he stood it in their midst, and embracing it, he said to them:

37 Whoever receives one of such children in my name receives me; and whoever receives me does not receive me, but the one who sent me.

38 And John answered him, saying: Teacher, we saw someone casting out demons in your name, who does not follow us, and we hindered him because he does not follow us.

39 But Jesus said: Do not hinder him, for there is no one who shall perform a mighty work in my name and shall be able quickly to speak evil of me.

40 For he who is not against you is for you.

41 For whoever gives you a cup of water to drink in my name because you are Christ's, amen, I say to you: He shall certainly not lose his reward.

42 And whoever makes one of the little ones who believe in me stumble, it is better for him rather if a millstone lies around his neck and he has been cast into the sea.

43 And if your hand makes you stumble, cut it off; it is good for you to enter into life maimed, rather than having the two hands to go away into Gehenna, into the unquenchable fire,

44 where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.

45 And if your foot makes you stumble, cut it off; it is good for you to enter into life lame, rather than having the two feet to be cast into Gehenna, into the unquenchable fire,

46 where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.

47 And if your eye makes you stumble, cast it out; it is good for you to enter into the kingdom of God one-eyed, rather than having two eyes to be cast into the Gehenna of fire,

48 where their worm does not die and the fire is not quenched.

49 For everyone shall be salted with fire, and every sacrifice shall be salted with salt.

50 The salt is good; but if the salt becomes saltless, with what shall you season it? Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace with one another.

Chapter 10

1 And rising from there, he comes into the borders of Judea through the region beyond the Jordan, and crowds come together to him again, and as he was accustomed, again he was teaching them.

2 And the Pharisees approached and questioned him whether it is lawful for a man to dismiss a wife, testing him.

3 And he answered and said to them: What did Moses command you?

4 And they said: Moses permitted to write a document of divorce and dismiss her.

5 And Jesus answered and said to them: In view of your hardness of heart he wrote this commandment for you.

6 But from the beginning of creation God made them male and female.

7 Because of this a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife,

8 and the two shall be into one flesh; so that they are no longer two, but one flesh.

9 What, therefore, God joined together, let man not separate.

10 And in the house his disciples again questioned him concerning the same thing.

11 And he says to them: Whoever dismisses his wife and marries another commits adultery against her.

12 And if a woman dismisses her husband and is married to another, she commits adultery.

13 And they were bringing children to him so that he might touch them, but the disciples were rebuking those bringing them.

14 And Jesus, seeing, was indignant and said to them: Allow the children to come to me, and do not hinder them, for of such is the kingdom of God.

15 Amen, I say to you: Whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a child shall certainly not enter into it.

16 And embracing them, laying his hands upon them, he was blessing them.

17 And as he went out onto a road, one ran to him and knelt to him and was questioning him: Good teacher, what shall I do so that I may inherit eternal life?

18 And Jesus said to him: Why do you call me good? No one is good except one, God.

19 You know the commandments: Do not commit adultery; do not murder; do not steal; do not testify falsely; do not defraud; honor your father and mother.

20 And he answered and said to him: Teacher, all these I have kept from my youth.

21 And Jesus looked at him and loved him and said to him: One thing is lacking to you; go, sell whatever you have and give to the poor, and you shall have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me, taking up the cross.

22 But he grew gloomy at the word and went away grieving, for he had many possessions.

23 And Jesus looked around and says to his disciples: How with difficulty shall those having wealth enter into the kingdom of God!

24 And the disciples were amazed at his words. And Jesus again answered and says to them: Children, how difficult it is for those who have trusted in wealth to enter into the kingdom of God!

25 It is easier for a camel to enter through the hole of the needle than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

26 And they were exceedingly astonished, saying among themselves: And who can be saved?

27 And looking at them, Jesus says: With men it is impossible, but not with God, for all things are possible with God.

28 And Peter began to say to him: Behold, we left everything and followed you.

29 And Jesus answered and said: Amen, I say to you: There is no one who left house or brothers or sisters or father or mother or wife or children or fields because of me and the good news,

30 unless he receives a hundredfold now in this time, houses and brothers and sisters and mothers and children and fields, with persecutions, and in the coming age eternal life.

31 But many first shall be last, and the last first.

32 And they were on the road going up to Jerusalem, and Jesus was going before them, and they were amazed, and following, they were fearing; and again taking the twelve with him, he began to tell them the things about to happen to him:

33 Behold, we go up to Jerusalem, and the Son of man shall be handed over to the chief priests and the scribes, and they shall condemn him to death and hand him over to the gentiles,

34 and they shall mock him and scourge him and spit upon him and kill him, and on the third day he shall rise.

35 And James and John, the sons of Zebedee, approach him, saying: Teacher, we wish that you do for us whatever we ask.

36 And he said to them: What do you wish me to do for you?

37 And they said to him: Give us that we may sit, one at your right and one at your left, in your glory.

38 And Jesus said to them: You do not know what you ask. Are you able to drink the cup which I drink, and to be baptized with the baptism with which I am baptized?

39 And they said to him: We are able. And Jesus said to them: The cup which I drink indeed you shall drink, and with the baptism with which I am baptized you shall be baptized.

40 But to sit at my right and at my left is not mine to give, but to those for whom it has been prepared.

41 And hearing, the ten began to be indignant concerning James and John.

42 And Jesus called them to him and says to them: You know that those considered to rule the nations lord over them, and their great men exercise authority over them.

43 But it shall not be so among you; rather, whoever wishes to become great among you shall be your servant.

44 And whoever wishes to become first of you shall be slave of all.

45 For even the Son of man did not come to be served, but to serve, and to give his soul as a ransom for many.

46 And they come into Jericho; and as he went out from Jericho, and his disciples and a considerable crowd, the son of Timaeus, Bartimaeus the blind man, was sitting beside the road begging.

47 And hearing that it is Jesus the Nazarene, he began to cry out and say: Son of David, Jesus, have mercy on me.

48 And many were rebuking him so that he should be silent; but he was crying out much more: Son of David, have mercy on me.

49 And Jesus stood and said that he should be called; and they call the blind man, saying to him: Take courage; rise, he calls you.

50 And casting away his garment, he rose and came to Jesus.

51 And Jesus answered and says to him: What do you wish me to do for you? And the blind man said to him: Rabboni, that I may see again.

52 And Jesus said to him: Go; your faith has saved you. And immediately he saw again and was following Jesus on the road.

Chapter 11

1 And when they draw near to Jerusalem, to Bethphage and Bethany, toward the mountain of Olives, he sends two of his disciples,

2 and says to them: Go into the village opposite you, and immediately entering into it, you shall find a colt bound, upon which no man has sat; loose it and bring it.

3 And if anyone says to you: Why do you do this? Say: Its Lord has need of it, and immediately he shall send it here.

4 And they went away and found the colt bound at the door outside upon the street, and they loose it.

5 And some of those standing there were saying to them: What do you do, loosing the colt?

6 And they told them as Jesus commanded, and they allowed them.

7 And they brought the colt to Jesus and cast their garments upon it, and he sat upon it.

8 And many spread their garments into the road, and others were cutting leafy branches from the trees and spreading them into the road.

9 And those going before and those following were crying out, saying: Hosanna! Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!

10 Blessed is the coming kingdom in the name of the Lord, of our father David! Hosanna in the highest!

11 And Jesus entered into Jerusalem and into the temple, and looking around at everything, the hour being already late, he went out into Bethany with the twelve.

12 And on the next day, when they went out from Bethany, he was hungry.

13 And seeing a fig tree from afar having leaves, he came, if perhaps he would find anything on it, and coming to it, found nothing except leaves, for it was not a season of figs.

14 And Jesus answered and said to it: May no one any longer eat fruit from you forever. And his disciples were hearing.

15 And they come into Jerusalem, and Jesus entered into the temple and began to cast out those selling and buying in the temple, and overturned the tables of the money changers and the seats of those selling the doves.

16 And he was not allowing anyone to carry a vessel through the temple.

17 And he was teaching, saying to them: Is it not written that my house shall be called a house of prayer for all the nations? But you made it a cave of robbers.

18 And the scribes and the chief priests heard, and were seeking how they would destroy him, for they feared him, because the whole crowd was astonished at his teaching.

19 And when it became late, he was going out of the city.

20 And in the morning, passing by, they saw the fig tree withered from the roots.

21 And Peter remembered and says to him: Rabbi, see, the fig tree which you cursed has withered.

22 And Jesus answered and says to them: Have faith in God.

23 For amen, I say to you that whoever says to this mountain: Be lifted and cast into the sea, and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says happens, he shall have whatever he says.

24 For this reason I say to you: All things, whatever you ask praying, believe that you receive, and they shall be yours.

25 And whenever you stand praying, forgive if you have anything against anyone, so that your Father who is in the heavens also may forgive you your trespasses.

26 But if you do not forgive, neither shall your Father who is in the heavens forgive your trespasses.

27 And they come again into Jerusalem, and while he walks in the temple, the chief priests and the scribes and the elders come to him,

28 and say to him: By what authority do you do these things? And who gave you this authority so that you do these things?

29 And Jesus answered and said to them: I also shall question you with one word, and answer me, and I shall tell you by what authority I do these things.

30 Was the baptism of John from heaven or from men? Answer me.

31 And they were reasoning among themselves, saying: If we say: From heaven, he shall say: Why, then, did you not believe him?

32 But if we say: From men; they feared the people, for all held John, that he truly was a prophet.

33 And answering, they say to Jesus: We do not know. And Jesus answered and says to them: Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.

Chapter 12

1 And he began to speak to them in parables: A man planted a vineyard and put a fence around it and dug a winepress vat and built a tower, and leased it to farmers and went abroad.

2 And he sent a slave to the farmers in the season, so that from the farmers he might receive from the fruit of the vineyard.

3 But they took him and beat him and sent him away empty.

4 And again he sent another slave to them, and that one they stoned and wounded in the head and sent away dishonored.

5 And again he sent another, and that one they killed, and many others, beating some and killing others.

6 Therefore, still having one son, his beloved, he sent him also to them last, saying: They shall respect my son.

7 But those farmers said among themselves: This is the heir; come, let us kill him, and the inheritance shall be ours.

8 And taking him, they killed him and cast him outside the vineyard.

9 What, therefore, shall the lord of the vineyard do? He shall come and destroy the farmers and give the vineyard to others.

10 Have you not even read this Scripture: The stone which the builders rejected, this became the head of the corner;

11 this came from the Lord, and it is marvelous in our eyes?

12 And they were seeking to seize him, and feared the crowd, for they knew that he spoke the parable against them; and leaving him, they went away.

13 And they send to him some of the Pharisees and of the Herodians, so that they might catch him in a word.

14 And they came and say to him: Teacher, we know that you are true and care concerning no one, for you do not look upon the face of men, but in truth teach the way of God. Is it lawful to give tax to Caesar or not?

15 Shall we give or not give? But knowing their hypocrisy, he said to them: Why do you test me? Bring me a denarius so that I may see.

16 And they brought it, and he says to them: Whose is this image and the inscription? And they said to him: Caesar's.

17 And Jesus answered and said to them: Repay the things of Caesar to Caesar, and the things of God to God. And they marveled at him.

18 And Sadducees come to him, who say there is no resurrection, and questioned him, saying:

19 Teacher, Moses wrote to us that if anyone's brother dies and leaves a wife and leaves no children, his brother should take his wife and raise up seed for his brother.

20 There were seven brothers, and the first took a wife, and dying, left no seed.

21 And the second took her and died, and neither did he leave seed, and the third likewise.

22 And the seven took her and left no seed; last of all the woman also died.

23 In the resurrection, therefore, when they rise, whose wife of them shall she be? For the seven had her as wife.

24 And Jesus answered and said to them: Is it not because of this that you wander, not knowing the Scriptures nor the power of God?

25 For when they rise from the dead, they neither marry nor are given in marriage, but are like angels who are in the heavens.

26 But concerning the dead, that they are raised, have you not read in the book of Moses, at the bush, how God spoke to him, saying: I am the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob?

27 He is not God of the dead, but God of the living; therefore you wander greatly.

28 And one of the scribes approached and heard them debating, and knowing that he answered them well, questioned him: Which is the first commandment of all?

29 And Jesus answered him: The first of all the commandments: Hear, Israel; the Lord our God is one Lord.

30 And you shall love the Lord your God from your whole heart and from your whole soul and from your whole mind and from your whole strength. This is the first commandment.

31 And a second like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself. There is no other commandment greater than these.

32 And the scribe said to him: Well, teacher, in truth you said that God is one, and there is no other except him.

33 And to love him from the whole heart and from the whole understanding and from the whole soul and from the whole strength, and to love the neighbor as oneself, is more than all the whole burnt offerings and the sacrifices.

34 And Jesus, seeing that he answered intelligently, said to him: You are not far from the kingdom of God. And no one any longer dared to question him.

35 And Jesus answered and was saying, teaching in the temple: How do the scribes say that the Christ is David's son?

36 For David himself said in the Holy Spirit: The Lord said to my Lord: Sit at my right until I place your enemies as a footstool of your feet.

37 Therefore David himself calls him Lord, and from where is he his son? And the great crowd was hearing him gladly.

38 And he was saying to them in his teaching: Beware of the scribes, who wish to walk in robes, and greetings in the marketplaces,

39 and first seats in the synagogues and first reclining places at the suppers,

40 who devour the houses of the widows, and with a pretext pray long; these shall receive greater judgment.

41 And Jesus sat opposite the treasury and was watching how the crowd casts copper into the treasury, and many rich men were casting much.

42 And one poor widow came and cast two lepta, which is a quadrans.

43 And calling his disciples to him, he says to them: Amen, I say to you that this poor widow has cast more than all those who cast into the treasury.

44 For all cast from what abounds to them, but she from her lack cast everything she had, her whole livelihood.

Chapter 13

1 And as he went out from the temple, one of his disciples says to him: Teacher, see, what manner of stones and what manner of buildings!

2 And Jesus answered and said to him: Do you see these great buildings? There shall certainly not be left a stone upon a stone which shall certainly not be demolished.

3 And while he sat on the mountain of Olives opposite the temple, Peter and James and John and Andrew were questioning him privately:

4 Tell us, when shall these things be, and what is the sign when all these things are about to be completed?

5 And Jesus answered them and began to say: See that no one leads you astray.

6 For many shall come in my name, saying: I am, and shall lead many astray.

7 And when you hear wars and reports of wars, do not be alarmed, for it must happen, but the end is not yet.

8 For nation shall rise against nation and kingdom against kingdom, and there shall be earthquakes in places, and there shall be famines and disturbances; these are beginnings of birth pains.

9 But you, beware for yourselves, for they shall hand you over to councils, and in synagogues you shall be beaten, and before governors and kings you shall stand because of me, as a testimony to them.

10 And the good news must first be proclaimed to all the nations.

11 And when they lead you, handing you over, do not be anxious beforehand what to speak, nor rehearse, but whatever is given you in that hour, speak this; for it is not you who speak, but the Holy Spirit.

12 And brother shall hand brother over to death, and father a child, and children shall rise against parents and put them to death.

13 And you shall be hated by all because of my name; but he who endures until the end, this one shall be saved.

14 And when you see the abomination of desolation, spoken of by Daniel the prophet, standing where it ought not, let the reader perceive; then let those in Judea flee into the mountains.

15 And let the one upon the roof not descend into the house, nor enter to take anything out of his house.

16 And let the one who is in the field not turn back to take his garment.

17 And woe to those having in the womb and those nursing in those days!

18 And pray that your flight may not happen in winter.

19 For those days shall be affliction, such as has not happened from the beginning of creation which God created until now, and shall certainly not happen.

20 And unless the Lord shortened the days, no flesh would be saved; but because of the chosen whom he chose, he shortened the days.

21 And then if anyone says to you: Behold, here is the Christ, or: Behold, there, do not believe.

22 For false christs and false prophets shall rise and shall give signs and wonders to lead astray, if possible, even the chosen.

23 But you, beware; behold, I have told you everything beforehand.

24 But in those days, after that affliction, the sun shall be darkened and the moon shall not give its light,

25 and the stars of the heaven shall be falling out, and the powers in the heavens shall be shaken.

26 And then they shall see the Son of man coming in clouds with much power and glory.

27 And then he shall send his angels and gather his chosen together from the four winds, from the extremity of earth until the extremity of heaven.

28 And learn the parable from the fig tree: When its branch already becomes tender and puts forth the leaves, you know that summer is near.

29 So also you, when you see these things happening, know that it is near, at the doors.

30 Amen, I say to you that this generation shall certainly not pass until all these things happen.

31 The heaven and the earth shall pass away, but my words shall certainly not pass away.

32 But concerning that day and the hour no one knows, not even the angels who are in heaven, nor the Son, except the Father.

33 Beware, stay awake and pray, for you do not know when the time is.

34 As a man abroad, leaving his house and giving his slaves the authority and to each his work, and commanding the doorkeeper to keep watch.

35 Therefore keep watch, for you do not know when the lord of the house comes, late or at midnight or at rooster-crowing or early,

36 lest coming suddenly he find you sleeping.

37 And what I say to you I say to all: Keep watch.

Chapter 14

1 And the Passover and the unleavened bread were after two days, and the chief priests and the scribes were seeking how they might seize him by deceit and kill him.

2 But they were saying: Not during the feast, lest there be an uproar of the people.

3 And while he was in Bethany in the house of Simon the leper, reclining, a woman came having an alabaster vessel of very costly ointment of genuine nard, and breaking the alabaster vessel, she poured it down upon his head.

4 And some were indignant among themselves and saying: Why has this waste of the ointment happened?

5 For this could have been sold for above three hundred denarii and given to the poor. And they were sternly scolding her.

6 But Jesus said: Leave her; why do you give her troubles? She has worked a good work toward me.

7 For you always have the poor with yourselves, and whenever you wish, you can do them good; but you do not always have me.

8 What she had, she did; she anticipated anointing my body for the burial.

9 Amen, I say to you: Wherever this good news is proclaimed into the whole world, what she did also shall be spoken of as a memorial of her.

10 And Judas Iscariot, one of the twelve, went away to the chief priests to hand him over to them.

11 And hearing, they rejoiced and promised to give him silver; and he was seeking how he might opportunely hand him over.

12 And on the first day of the unleavened bread, when they were sacrificing the Passover, his disciples say to him: Where do you wish us to go and prepare so that you may eat the Passover?

13 And he sends two of his disciples and says to them: Go into the city, and a man carrying a pitcher of water shall meet you; follow him.

14 And wherever he enters, tell the master of the house: The teacher says: Where is the lodging where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?

15 And he shall show you a great upper room, furnished, ready; there prepare for us.

16 And his disciples went out and came into the city and found as he told them, and prepared the Passover.

17 And when evening came, he comes with the twelve.

18 And while they reclined and ate, Jesus said: Amen, I say to you that one of you shall hand me over, the one eating with me.

19 And they began to be grieved and to say to him one by one: Surely not I? And another: Surely not I?

20 And he answered and said to them: One of the twelve, the one dipping with me into the dish.

21 The Son of man indeed goes as it is written concerning him, but woe to that man through whom the Son of man is handed over! It was good for him if that man had not been born.

22 And while they ate, Jesus took bread and blessed and broke it and gave it to them, and said: Take, eat; this is my body.

23 And taking the cup, he gave thanks and gave it to them, and all drank from it.

24 And he said to them: This is my blood, that of the new covenant, poured out concerning many.

25 Amen, I say to you that I shall certainly no longer drink from the produce of the vine until that day when I drink it new in the kingdom of God.

26 And having sung a hymn, they went out to the mountain of Olives.

27 And Jesus says to them: All shall be made to stumble at me in this night, because it is written: I shall strike the shepherd, and the sheep shall be scattered.

28 But after I am raised, I shall go before you into Galilee.

29 And Peter said to him: Even if all shall be made to stumble, yet not I.

30 And Jesus says to him: Amen, I say to you that today in this night, before a rooster calls twice, you shall deny me three times.

31 But he was saying more exceedingly: If I must die together with you, I shall certainly not deny you. And likewise all also were saying.

32 And they come into a place whose name is Gethsemane, and he says to his disciples: Sit here until I pray.

33 And he takes Peter and James and John with himself, and began to be greatly troubled and distressed.

34 And he says to them: My soul is exceedingly sorrowful until death; remain here and keep watch.

35 And going forward a little, he fell upon the earth and was praying that, if it is possible, the hour might pass from him.

36 And he was saying: Abba, Father, all things are possible for you; carry this cup away from me; but not what I wish, but what you.

37 And he comes and finds them sleeping, and says to Peter: Simon, do you sleep? Were you not strong enough to keep watch one hour?

38 Keep watch and pray so that you may not enter into temptation; the spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh weak.

39 And again going away, he prayed, saying the same word.

40 And returning, he found them sleeping again, for their eyes were weighed down, and they did not know what to answer him.

41 And he comes the third time and says to them: Sleep the rest and take your rest; it is enough, the hour came; behold, the Son of man is handed over into the hands of sinners.

42 Rise, let us go; behold, the one handing me over has drawn near.

43 And immediately, while he was still speaking, Judas arrives, being one of the twelve, and with him a great crowd with swords and clubs from the chief priests and the scribes and the elders.

44 And the one handing him over had given them an agreed sign, saying: Whomever I kiss, he is the one; seize him and lead him away securely.

45 And coming, immediately approaching him, he says: Rabbi, Rabbi; and kissed him fervently.

46 And they laid their hands upon him and seized him.

47 And a certain one of those standing by drew the sword and struck the slave of the high priest and took off his ear.

48 And Jesus answered and said to them: As against a robber you came out with swords and clubs to arrest me.

49 Daily I was with you in the temple, teaching, and you did not seize me; but so that the Scriptures might be fulfilled.

50 And leaving him, all fled.

51 And a certain young man was following him, clothed in a linen cloth upon his naked body, and the young men seize him.

52 But he left the linen cloth and fled naked from them.

53 And they led Jesus away to the high priest, and all the chief priests and the elders and the scribes come together to him.

54 And Peter followed him from afar until inside into the courtyard of the high priest, and was sitting together with the attendants and warming himself by the light.

55 And the chief priests and the whole council were seeking testimony against Jesus to put him to death, and were not finding it.

56 For many were testifying falsely against him, and the testimonies were not equal.

57 And some stood up and were testifying falsely against him, saying:

58 We heard him saying: I shall demolish this sanctuary made by hands, and through three days I shall build another not made by hands.

59 And not even so was their testimony equal.

60 And the high priest stood up into the midst and questioned Jesus, saying: Do you answer nothing? What do these testify against you?

61 But he was silent and answered nothing. Again the high priest was questioning him and says to him: Are you the Christ, the Son of the Blessed One?

62 And Jesus said: I am, and you shall see the Son of man sitting at the right of the Power and coming with the clouds of the heaven.

63 And the high priest tore his tunics and says: What further need do we have of witnesses?

64 You heard the blasphemy; what does it appear to you? And all condemned him to be liable to death.

65 And some began to spit upon him and cover his face and strike him with fists and say to him: Prophesy; and the attendants were striking him with slaps.

66 And while Peter was below in the courtyard, one of the servant girls of the high priest comes,

67 and seeing Peter warming himself, she looked at him and says: You also were with Jesus the Nazarene.

68 But he denied, saying: I do not know nor understand what you say. And he went outside into the forecourt, and a rooster called.

69 And the servant girl saw him again and began to say to those standing by: This man is one of them.

70 But he was denying again. And after a little while, again those standing by were saying to Peter: Truly you are one of them, for you are also a Galilean, and your speech resembles theirs.

71 But he began to curse and swear: I do not know this man of whom you speak.

72 And a rooster called a second time, and Peter remembered the saying which Jesus said to him: Before a rooster calls twice, you shall deny me three times; and thinking upon it, he was weeping.

Chapter 15

1 And immediately in the morning the chief priests took counsel with the elders and scribes and the whole council, and binding Jesus, carried him away and handed him over to Pilate.

2 And Pilate questioned him: Are you the king of the Jews? And he answered and said to him: You say it.

3 And the chief priests were accusing him of many things.

4 And Pilate again questioned him, saying: Do you answer nothing? See how many things they testify against you.

5 But Jesus no longer answered anything, so that Pilate marveled.

6 And at a feast he was releasing to them one prisoner whom they asked for.

7 And the one called Barabbas was bound with the fellow insurgents, who in the insurrection had committed murder.

8 And the crowd cried aloud and began to ask as he always did for them.

9 And Pilate answered them, saying: Do you wish me to release to you the king of the Jews?

10 For he knew that because of envy the chief priests had handed him over.

11 But the chief priests stirred up the crowd so that he should rather release Barabbas to them.

12 And Pilate answered and again said to them: What, therefore, do you wish me to do with the one you call king of the Jews?

13 And they again cried out: Crucify him.

14 And Pilate was saying to them: For what evil did he do? But they cried out more abundantly: Crucify him.

15 And Pilate, wishing to do what was sufficient for the crowd, released Barabbas to them, and scourged Jesus and handed him over to be crucified.

16 And the soldiers led him away inside the courtyard, which is the praetorium, and they call together the whole cohort.

17 And they clothe him in purple and put around him a crown of thorns which they wove,

18 and began to greet him: Greetings, king of the Jews.

19 And they were striking his head with a reed and spitting upon him, and bending their knees, were worshiping him.

20 And when they mocked him, they stripped the purple from him and clothed him in his own garments, and lead him out to crucify him.

21 And they compel a certain passerby, Simon a Cyrenian, coming from a field, the father of Alexander and Rufus, to take up his cross.

22 And they bring him to a place, Golgotha, which is translated: Place of a Skull.

23 And they were giving him wine mixed with myrrh to drink, but he did not take it.

24 And crucifying him, they were dividing his garments, casting a lot upon them, who should take what.

25 And it was the third hour, and they crucified him.

26 And the inscription of his accusation was inscribed: The king of the Jews.

27 And with him they crucify two robbers, one at his right and one at his left.

28 And the Scripture was fulfilled which says: And he was reckoned with the lawless.

29 And those passing by were blaspheming him, moving their heads and saying: Ah! You who demolish the sanctuary and build it in three days,

30 save yourself and descend from the cross.

31 And likewise also the chief priests, mocking with one another with the scribes, were saying: He saved others; he cannot save himself.

32 Let the Christ, the king of Israel, descend now from the cross so that we may see and believe. And those crucified together with him were reproaching him.

33 And when the sixth hour came, darkness came upon the whole earth until the ninth hour.

34 And at the ninth hour Jesus cried with a great voice, saying: Eloi, Eloi, lamma sabachthani? Which is translated: My God, my God, for what did you forsake me?

35 And some of those standing by heard and were saying: Behold, he calls Elijah.

36 And one ran and filled a sponge with vinegar and put it on a reed and was giving him to drink, saying: Leave it; let us see whether Elijah comes to take him down.

37 And Jesus uttered a great voice and breathed out.

38 And the veil of the sanctuary was torn into two from above until below.

39 And the centurion standing opposite him, seeing that crying out so he breathed out, said: Truly this man was God's Son.

40 And there were also women watching from afar, among whom was also Mary Magdalene and Mary the mother of James the little and Joses, and Salome,

41 who also, when he was in Galilee, were following him and serving him, and many others who came up with him into Jerusalem.

42 And evening having already come, since it was Preparation, which is the day before the Sabbath,

43 Joseph from Arimathea came, an honorable councilor, who himself also was awaiting the kingdom of God; taking courage, he entered to Pilate and asked for the body of Jesus.

44 And Pilate marveled whether he has already died, and calling the centurion to him, questioned him whether he died some time ago.

45 And knowing from the centurion, he granted the body to Joseph.

46 And buying a linen cloth and taking him down, he wrapped him in the linen cloth and laid him in a tomb which had been hewn from rock, and rolled a stone against the door of the tomb.

47 And Mary Magdalene and Mary of Joses were watching where he is laid.

Chapter 16

1 And when the Sabbath had passed, Mary Magdalene and Mary of James and Salome bought spices so that they might come and anoint him.

2 And very early on the first day of the week they come to the tomb, the sun having risen.

3 And they were saying among themselves: Who shall roll away the stone for us from the door of the tomb?

4 And looking up, they see that the stone has been rolled away, for it was exceedingly great.

5 And entering into the tomb, they saw a young man sitting on the right, clothed in a white robe, and were greatly amazed.

6 And he says to them: Do not be greatly amazed; you seek Jesus the Nazarene, the one crucified; he was raised, he is not here; see the place where they laid him.

7 But go, tell his disciples and Peter that he goes before you into Galilee; there you shall see him, as he told you.

8 And going out quickly, they fled from the tomb, and trembling and astonishment held them, and they said nothing to anyone, for they feared.

9 And rising early on the first day of the week, he appeared first to Mary Magdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons.

10 She went and reported to those who had been with him, mourning and weeping.

11 And they, hearing that he lives and was seen by her, disbelieved.

12 And after these things he was manifested in another form to two of them walking, going into a field.

13 And they went away and reported to the rest; neither did they believe those.

14 Afterward he was manifested to the eleven themselves as they reclined, and reproached their unbelief and hardness of heart, because they did not believe those who saw him raised.

15 And he said to them: Go into the whole world and proclaim the good news to all the creation.

16 He who believes and is baptized shall be saved, but he who disbelieves shall be condemned.

17 And these signs shall accompany those who believe: In my name they shall cast out demons; they shall speak with new tongues;

18 they shall take up serpents, and even if they drink anything deadly, it shall certainly not harm them; they shall lay hands upon the sick, and they shall be well.

19 Therefore the Lord indeed, after speaking to them, was taken up into the heaven and sat at the right of God.

20 And they went out and proclaimed everywhere, the Lord working together and confirming the word through the accompanying signs. Amen.

Luke

Chapter 1

1 Since indeed many undertook to arrange a narrative concerning the matters fulfilled among us,

2 as those who from the beginning became eyewitnesses and attendants of the word handed down to us,

3 it seemed good to me also, having followed everything accurately from the beginning, to write to you in order, most excellent Theophilus,

4 so that you may recognize the certainty concerning the words in which you were instructed.

5 In the days of Herod king of Judea there was a certain priest named Zechariah, of the division of Abijah, and his wife was of the daughters of Aaron, and her name Elizabeth.

6 And both were righteous before God, walking blameless in all the commandments and ordinances of the Lord.

7 And they had no child, because Elizabeth was barren, and both were advanced in their days.

8 And it happened, while he served as priest in the order of his division before God,

9 according to the custom of the priesthood, he obtained by lot to burn incense, entering into the sanctuary of the Lord.

10 And the whole multitude of the people was praying outside at the hour of the incense.

11 And an angel of the Lord appeared to him, standing at the right of the altar of incense.

12 And Zechariah was troubled, seeing, and fear fell upon him.

13 But the angel said to him: Do not fear, Zechariah, because your petition was heard, and your wife Elizabeth shall bear you a son, and you shall call his name John.

14 And you shall have joy and exultation, and many shall rejoice at his birth.

15 For he shall be great before the Lord, and shall certainly not drink wine and strong drink, and shall be filled with the Holy Spirit even from his mother's womb.

16 And he shall turn many of the sons of Israel to the Lord their God.

17 And he shall go before him in the spirit and power of Elijah, to turn hearts of fathers to children, and the disobedient in the understanding of the righteous, to prepare for the Lord a people made ready.

18 And Zechariah said to the angel: By what shall I know this? For I am an old man, and my wife advanced in her days.

19 And the angel answered and said to him: I am Gabriel, who stands before God, and I was sent to speak to you and announce these good things to you.

20 And behold, you shall be silent and unable to speak until the day these things happen, because you did not believe my words, which shall be fulfilled in their time.

21 And the people were awaiting Zechariah, and were marveling at his delaying in the sanctuary.

22 But going out, he could not speak to them, and they recognized that he has seen a vision in the sanctuary; and he was making signs to them and remained mute.

23 And it happened, when the days of his ministry were fulfilled, he went away into his house.

24 And after these days Elizabeth his wife conceived, and was hiding herself five months, saying:

25 Thus the Lord has done for me in days in which he looked upon me to take away my reproach among men.

26 And in the sixth month the angel Gabriel was sent by God into a city of Galilee named Nazareth,

27 to a virgin betrothed to a man named Joseph, of the house of David, and the virgin's name was Mariam.

28 And the angel entered to her and said: Rejoice, you who have been graced; the Lord is with you; blessed are you among women.

29 And seeing, she was greatly troubled at his word, and was reasoning what manner of greeting this might be.

30 And the angel said to her: Do not fear, Mariam, for you found grace with God.

31 And behold, you shall conceive in the womb and bear a son, and shall call his name Jesus.

32 He shall be great and shall be called Son of the Most High, and the Lord God shall give him the throne of David his father,

33 and he shall reign over the house of Jacob into the ages, and of his kingdom there shall be no end.

34 And Mariam said to the angel: How shall this be, since I do not know a man?

35 And the angel answered and said to her: The Holy Spirit shall come upon you, and power of the Most High shall overshadow you; therefore also the holy thing being born shall be called Son of God.

36 And behold, Elizabeth your relative, she also has conceived a son in her old age, and this is the sixth month for her who is called barren.

37 Because no word shall be impossible with God.

38 And Mariam said: Behold, the slave woman of the Lord; may it happen to me according to your saying. And the angel went away from her.

39 And Mariam rose in these days and went into the hill country with haste, into a city of Judah,

40 and entered into the house of Zechariah and greeted Elizabeth.

41 And it happened, when Elizabeth heard the greeting of Mary, the infant leaped in her womb, and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy Spirit,

42 and cried aloud with a great voice and said: Blessed are you among women, and blessed is the fruit of your womb.

43 And from where is this for me, that the mother of my Lord should come to me?

44 For behold, when the voice of your greeting came into my ears, the infant in my womb leaped in exultation.

45 And blessed is she who believed, because there shall be a fulfillment of the things spoken to her from the Lord.

46 And Mariam said: My soul magnifies the Lord,

47 and my spirit exulted in God my Savior,

48 because he looked upon the lowliness of his slave woman; for behold, from now all generations shall call me blessed,

49 because the Mighty One did great things for me, and holy is his name,

50 and his mercy is into generations of generations to those fearing him.

51 He made strength with his arm; he scattered the arrogant in the thought of their heart.

52 He took rulers down from thrones and exalted the lowly.

53 He filled the hungry with good things and sent the rich away empty.

54 He helped Israel his servant, to remember mercy,

55 as he spoke to our fathers, to Abraham and to his seed forever.

56 And Mariam remained with her about three months, and returned into her house.

57 And for Elizabeth the time was fulfilled for her to give birth, and she bore a son.

58 And her neighbors and relatives heard that the Lord magnified his mercy with her, and were rejoicing with her.

59 And it happened on the eighth day, they came to circumcise the child, and were calling it by the name of its father, Zechariah.

60 And his mother answered and said: No, but he shall be called John.

61 And they said to her: There is no one among your relatives who is called by this name.

62 And they were making signs to his father, what he might wish him to be called.

63 And asking for a little tablet, he wrote, saying: John is his name. And all marveled.

64 And immediately his mouth was opened, and his tongue, and he was speaking, blessing God.

65 And fear came upon all those dwelling around them, and in the whole hill country of Judea all these sayings were being discussed.

66 And all who heard put them in their heart, saying: What, then, shall this child be? And the hand of the Lord was with him.

67 And Zechariah his father was filled with the Holy Spirit and prophesied, saying:

68 Blessed is the Lord God of Israel, because he visited and made redemption for his people,

69 and raised a horn of salvation for us in the house of David his servant,

70 as he spoke through the mouth of his holy prophets from of old,

71 salvation from our enemies and from the hand of all who hate us,

72 to do mercy with our fathers and to remember his holy covenant,

73 the oath which he swore to Abraham our father,

74 to give us, rescued from the hand of our enemies, to serve him without fear,

75 in holiness and righteousness before him all the days of our life.

76 And you, child, shall be called prophet of the Most High, for you shall go before the face of the Lord to prepare his ways,

77 to give knowledge of salvation to his people in forgiveness of their sins,

78 because of the inward mercy of our God, in which the dawn from on high visited us,

79 to shine upon those sitting in darkness and shadow of death, to direct our feet into a way of peace.

80 And the child was growing and becoming strong in spirit, and was in the deserts until the day of his manifestation to Israel.

Chapter 2

1 And it happened in those days, a decree went out from Caesar Augustus that the whole inhabited world be registered.

2 This registration first happened while Quirinius governed Syria.

3 And all were going to be registered, each into his own city.

4 And Joseph also went up from Galilee, from the city Nazareth, into Judea, into David's city which is called Bethlehem, because he was of the house and family of David,

5 to be registered with Mariam, the wife betrothed to him, who was pregnant.

6 And it happened, while they were there, the days were fulfilled for her to give birth.

7 And she bore her firstborn son and swaddled him and laid him in the manger, because there was no place for them in the lodging.

8 And there were shepherds in the same region staying in the fields and keeping watches of the night over their flock.

9 And behold, an angel of the Lord stood by them, and the glory of the Lord shone around them, and they feared a great fear.

10 And the angel said to them: Do not fear, for behold, I announce to you great joy which shall be for all the people,

11 because a Savior was born for you today, who is Christ the Lord, in David's city.

12 And this is the sign for you: You shall find an infant swaddled, lying in the manger.

13 And suddenly with the angel there was a multitude of a heavenly army, praising God and saying:

14 Glory to God in the highest, and upon earth peace, goodwill among men.

15 And it happened, when the angels went away from them into the heaven, the men, the shepherds, said to one another: Let us indeed pass through until Bethlehem and see this saying which has happened, which the Lord made known to us.

16 And they came hastening and found both Mariam and Joseph, and the infant lying in the manger.

17 And seeing, they made known concerning the saying spoken to them concerning this child.

18 And all who heard marveled concerning the things spoken to them by the shepherds.

19 But Mariam was keeping all these sayings, bringing them together in her heart.

20 And the shepherds returned, glorifying and praising God over everything which they heard and saw, as it was spoken to them.

21 And when eight days were fulfilled for circumcising the child, his name also was called Jesus, the name called by the angel before he was conceived in the womb.

22 And when the days of their cleansing were fulfilled according to the law of Moses, they brought him up into Jerusalem to present him to the Lord,

23 as it is written in the law of the Lord: Every male opening a womb shall be called holy to the Lord,

24 and to give a sacrifice according to what is said in the law of the Lord: A pair of turtledoves or two young pigeons.

25 And behold, there was a man in Jerusalem named Simeon, and this man was righteous and devout, awaiting the consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit was upon him.

26 And it had been revealed to him by the Holy Spirit not to see death before he should see the Christ of the Lord.

27 And he came in the Spirit into the temple, and when the parents brought in the child Jesus to do concerning him according to the custom of the law,

28 he also received him into his arms and blessed God and said:

29 Now you release your slave, Master, according to your saying, in peace,

30 because my eyes saw your salvation,

31 which you prepared before the face of all the peoples,

32 a light for revelation of nations and glory of your people Israel.

33 And Joseph and his mother were marveling at the things spoken concerning him.

34 And Simeon blessed them and said to Mariam his mother: Behold, this one is appointed for falling and rising of many in Israel, and for a sign spoken against,

35 and a sword shall pass through your own soul also, so that reasonings from many hearts may be revealed.

36 And there was Anna a prophetess, daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of Asher; she was advanced in many days, having lived with a husband seven years from her virginity,

37 and she was a widow of about eighty-four years, who did not depart from the temple, serving with fastings and petitions night and day.

38 And she, standing by in that very hour, was giving thanks to the Lord and speaking concerning him to all those awaiting redemption in Jerusalem.

39 And when they finished everything according to the law of the Lord, they returned into Galilee, into their city Nazareth.

40 And the child was growing and becoming strong in spirit, being filled with wisdom, and grace of God was upon him.

41 And his parents were going yearly into Jerusalem at the feast of the Passover.

42 And when he became twelve years old, they went up into Jerusalem according to the custom of the feast,

43 and having completed the days, as they returned, the boy Jesus remained in Jerusalem, and Joseph and his mother did not know.

44 And supposing him to be in the company, they came a day's journey and were searching for him among the relatives and acquaintances.

45 And not finding him, they returned into Jerusalem, seeking him.

46 And it happened after three days, they found him in the temple, sitting in the midst of the teachers, both hearing them and questioning them.

47 And all hearing him were astonished at his understanding and answers.

48 And seeing him, they were amazed, and his mother said to him: Child, why did you do so to us? Behold, your father and I were seeking you in pain.

49 And he said to them: Why is it that you were seeking me? Did you not know that I must be in the things of my Father?

50 And they did not understand the saying which he spoke to them.

51 And he descended with them and came into Nazareth and was subject to them; and his mother was keeping all these sayings in her heart.

52 And Jesus was advancing in wisdom and age and grace with God and men.

Chapter 3

1 And in the fifteenth year of the rule of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate governing Judea, and Herod being tetrarch of Galilee, and Philip his brother being tetrarch of the region of Iturea and Trachonitis, and Lysanias being tetrarch of Abilene,

2 under high priests Annas and Caiaphas, a word of God came upon John the son of Zechariah in the desert.

3 And he came into the whole surrounding region of the Jordan, proclaiming a baptism of repentance for forgiveness of sins,

4 as it is written in the book of words of Isaiah the prophet, saying: A voice of one crying in the desert: Prepare the way of the Lord; make his paths straight.

5 Every ravine shall be filled, and every mountain and hill shall be humbled, and the crooked things shall become straight, and the rough ways smooth ways,

6 and all flesh shall see the salvation of God.

7 Therefore he was saying to the crowds going out to be baptized by him: Offspring of vipers, who showed you to flee from the coming wrath?

8 Therefore produce fruits worthy of repentance, and do not begin to say among yourselves: We have Abraham as father; for I say to you that God can raise children for Abraham from these stones.

9 And already the axe also lies at the root of the trees; therefore every tree not producing good fruit is cut down and cast into fire.

10 And the crowds were questioning him, saying: What, therefore, shall we do?

11 And he answered and says to them: He who has two tunics, let him share with the one not having, and he who has foods, let him do likewise.

12 And tax collectors also came to be baptized and said to him: Teacher, what shall we do?

13 And he said to them: Collect nothing more than what has been directed for you.

14 And soldiers also were questioning him, saying: And we, what shall we do? And he said to them: Extort no one nor accuse falsely, and be content with your wages.

15 And while the people awaited, and all were reasoning in their hearts concerning John, whether he might be the Christ,

16 John answered all, saying: I indeed baptize you with water, but the one stronger than I comes, whose strap of his sandals I am not sufficient to loose; he shall baptize you in the Holy Spirit and fire,

17 whose winnowing shovel is in his hand, and he shall thoroughly cleanse his threshing floor and gather the wheat into his storehouse, but the chaff he shall burn up with unquenchable fire.

18 Therefore, exhorting with many other things also, he was announcing good news to the people.

19 But Herod the tetrarch, being reproved by him concerning Herodias, the wife of Philip his brother, and concerning all the evil things which Herod did,

20 added this also to all, and shut John in the prison.

21 And it happened, when all the people were baptized, and Jesus was baptized and praying, the heaven was opened,

22 and the Holy Spirit descended in bodily form like a dove upon him, and a voice came from heaven, saying: You are my beloved Son; in you I was well pleased.

23 And Jesus himself was about thirty years old, beginning, being, as was supposed, son of Joseph, of Heli,

24 of Matthat, of Levi, of Melchi, of Janna, of Joseph,

25 of Mattathias, of Amos, of Nahum, of Esli, of Naggai,

26 of Maath, of Mattathias, of Semei, of Joseph, of Judah,

27 of Joanna, of Rhesa, of Zerubbabel, of Salathiel, of Neri,

28 of Melchi, of Addi, of Cosam, of Elmodam, of Er,

29 of Joses, of Eliezer, of Joreim, of Matthat, of Levi,

30 of Simeon, of Judah, of Joseph, of Jonan, of Eliakim,

31 of Melea, of Mainan, of Mattatha, of Nathan, of David,

32 of Jesse, of Obed, of Boaz, of Salmon, of Naasson,

33 of Aminadab, of Aram, of Esrom, of Phares, of Judah,

34 of Jacob, of Isaac, of Abraham, of Thara, of Nachor,

35 of Saruch, of Ragau, of Phalek, of Eber, of Sala,

36 of Cainan, of Arphaxad, of Shem, of Noah, of Lamech,

37 of Mathusala, of Enoch, of Jared, of Maleleel, of Cainan,

38 of Enos, of Seth, of Adam, of God.

Chapter 4

1 And Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned from the Jordan and was being led in the Spirit into the desert,

2 forty days being tempted by the devil; and he ate nothing in those days, and when they were completed, afterward he was hungry.

3 And the devil said to him: If you are God's Son, tell this stone to become bread.

4 And Jesus answered him, saying: It is written that man shall not live upon bread alone, but upon every word of God.

5 And the devil brought him up into a high mountain and showed him all the kingdoms of the inhabited world in a moment of time.

6 And the devil said to him: I shall give you all this authority and their glory, because it has been handed over to me, and I give it to whomever I wish.

7 Therefore, if you worship before me, everything shall be yours.

8 And Jesus answered him and said: Go behind me, Satan, for it is written: You shall worship the Lord your God, and him alone you shall serve.

9 And he led him into Jerusalem and stood him upon the pinnacle of the temple and said to him: If you are God's Son, cast yourself down from here,

10 for it is written that he shall command his angels concerning you to guard you,

11 and that upon hands they shall take you up, lest you strike your foot against a stone.

12 And Jesus answered and said to him: It is said: You shall not test the Lord your God.

13 And completing every temptation, the devil departed from him until a time.

14 And Jesus returned in the power of the Spirit into Galilee, and a report concerning him went out throughout the whole surrounding region.

15 And he was teaching in their synagogues, being glorified by all.

16 And he came into Nazareth, where he had been brought up, and entered according to his custom on the Sabbath day into the synagogue, and rose to read.

17 And a book of Isaiah the prophet was handed to him, and unrolling the book, he found the place where it was written:

18 The Spirit of the Lord is upon me, because he anointed me to announce good news to the poor; he has sent me to heal those broken in heart, to proclaim release to captives and recovery of sight to the blind, to send those crushed away in release,

19 to proclaim an acceptable year of the Lord.

20 And rolling the book and giving it back to the attendant, he sat down, and the eyes of all in the synagogue were gazing at him.

21 And he began to say to them: Today this Scripture has been fulfilled in your ears.

22 And all were testifying to him and marveling at the words of grace coming out of his mouth, and were saying: Is this not Joseph's son?

23 And he said to them: Certainly you shall say this parable to me: Physician, heal yourself; whatever we heard happened in Capernaum, do also here in your homeland.

24 And he said: Amen, I say to you that no prophet is acceptable in his homeland.

25 But in truth I say to you: Many widows were in Israel in Elijah's days, when the heaven was shut for three years and six months, when a great famine came upon the whole earth,

26 and Elijah was sent to none of them except to Sarepta of Sidon, to a widow woman.

27 And many lepers were in Israel under Elisha the prophet, and none of them was cleansed except Naaman the Syrian.

28 And all in the synagogue were filled with rage, hearing these things,

29 and rising, cast him outside the city and led him until the brow of the mountain upon which their city had been built, to throw him down the precipice.

30 But he passed through their midst and was going away.

31 And he descended into Capernaum, a city of Galilee, and was teaching them on the Sabbath.

32 And they were astonished at his teaching, because his word was with authority.

33 And in the synagogue was a man having a spirit of an unclean demon, and he cried out with a great voice,

34 saying: Ah! What is between us and you, Jesus the Nazarene? Did you come to destroy us? I know you, who you are: the Holy One of God.

35 And Jesus rebuked him, saying: Be silenced and come out of him. And the demon threw him into the midst and came out from him, harming him nothing.

36 And amazement came upon all, and they were speaking with one another, saying: What is this word, that with authority and power he commands the unclean spirits, and they come out?

37 And a report concerning him was going out into every place of the surrounding region.

38 And rising from the synagogue, he entered into Simon's house; and Simon's mother-in-law was held by a great fever, and they asked him concerning her.

39 And standing over her, he rebuked the fever, and it left her; and immediately rising, she was serving them.

40 And as the sun set, all who had people sick with various diseases brought them to him; and laying his hands upon each one of them, he healed them.

41 And demons also were coming out from many, crying and saying: You are the Christ, the Son of God. And rebuking, he did not allow them to speak, because they knew him to be the Christ.

42 And when day came, he went out and went into a deserted place; and the crowds were seeking him and came to him and were holding him back from going away from them.

43 But he said to them: I must announce the kingdom of God to the other cities also, because for this I have been sent.

44 And he was proclaiming in the synagogues of Galilee.

Chapter 5

1 And it happened, while the crowd pressed upon him to hear the word of God, he was standing beside the lake of Gennesaret,

2 and saw two boats standing beside the lake, but the fishermen had gone out of them and were washing the nets.

3 And entering into one of the boats, which was Simon's, he asked him to put out a little from the earth; and sitting down, he was teaching the crowds from the boat.

4 And when he ceased speaking, he said to Simon: Put out into the deep, and lower your nets for a catch.

5 And Simon answered and said to him: Master, laboring through the whole night, we took nothing; but upon your saying I shall lower the net.

6 And doing this, they enclosed a great multitude of fish, and their net was tearing.

7 And they signaled to the partners in the other boat to come and help them; and they came and filled both boats, so that they were sinking.

8 And Simon Peter, seeing, fell at Jesus' knees, saying: Go out from me, because I am a sinful man, Lord.

9 For amazement encompassed him and all those with him at the catch of fish which they took,

10 and likewise James and John, sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon. And Jesus said to Simon: Do not fear; from now you shall be catching men alive.

11 And bringing the boats to the earth, they left everything and followed him.

12 And it happened while he was in one of the cities, behold, a man full of leprosy; and seeing Jesus, he fell upon his face and petitioned him, saying: Lord, if you wish, you can cleanse me.

13 And stretching out his hand, he touched him, saying: I wish; be cleansed. And immediately the leprosy went away from him.

14 And he commanded him to tell no one, but: Go, show yourself to the priest, and offer concerning your cleansing as Moses commanded, as a testimony to them.

15 But the word concerning him was spreading more, and many crowds were gathering to hear and to be healed by him from their illnesses.

16 But he was withdrawing in the deserts and praying.

17 And it happened on one of the days, he was teaching, and Pharisees and teachers of the law were sitting, who had come from every village of Galilee and Judea and Jerusalem; and power of the Lord was there to heal them.

18 And behold, men carrying upon a bed a man who was paralyzed, and they were seeking to bring him in and place him before him.

19 And not finding by what way to bring him in because of the crowd, they went up upon the roof and through the tiles let him down with the little bed into the midst before Jesus.

20 And seeing their faith, he said to him: Man, your sins have been forgiven you.

21 And the scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying: Who is this who speaks blasphemies? Who can forgive sins except God alone?

22 And Jesus recognized their reasonings and answered and said to them: What do you reason in your hearts?

23 Which is easier, to say: Your sins have been forgiven you, or to say: Rise and walk?

24 But so that you may know that the Son of man has authority upon the earth to forgive sins, he said to the paralyzed man: I say to you: Rise, and taking up your little bed, go into your house.

25 And immediately rising before them, he took up what he lay upon and went into his house, glorifying God.

26 And astonishment took all, and they were glorifying God and were filled with fear, saying: We saw extraordinary things today.

27 And after these things he went out and beheld a tax collector named Levi sitting at the tax office, and said to him: Follow me.

28 And leaving everything, he rose and followed him.

29 And Levi made a great reception for him in his house, and there was a great crowd of tax collectors and others who were reclining with them.

30 And their scribes and the Pharisees were grumbling to his disciples, saying: Why do you eat and drink with tax collectors and sinners?

31 And Jesus answered and said to them: Those healthy have no need of a physician, but those ill.

32 I have not come to call righteous men, but sinners to repentance.

33 And they said to him: Why do John's disciples fast often and make petitions, and likewise those of the Pharisees, but yours eat and drink?

34 And he said to them: Can you make the sons of the bridal chamber fast while the bridegroom is with them?

35 But days shall come, and when the bridegroom is taken away from them, then they shall fast in those days.

36 And he also was telling them a parable: No one puts a patch of a new garment upon an old garment; otherwise he both tears the new, and the patch from the new does not agree with the old.

37 And no one puts new wine into old wineskins; otherwise the new wine shall burst the wineskins, and it shall be poured out, and the wineskins shall perish.

38 But new wine must be put into fresh wineskins, and both are preserved.

39 And no one who drinks old immediately wishes new, for he says: The old is better.

Chapter 6

1 And it happened on a second-first Sabbath, he passed through the grainfields, and his disciples were plucking the ears of grain and eating, rubbing them with their hands.

2 And some of the Pharisees said to them: Why do you do what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath?

3 And Jesus answered them and said: Have you not even read this which David did when he was hungry, he and those with him,

4 how he entered into the house of God and took the loaves of the presentation and ate, and also gave to those with him, which it is not lawful to eat except for the priests alone?

5 And he was saying to them that the Son of man is Lord also of the Sabbath.

6 And it happened also on another Sabbath, he entered into the synagogue and taught, and there was a man there, and his right hand was withered.

7 And the scribes and the Pharisees were watching him, whether he would heal on the Sabbath, so that they might find an accusation against him.

8 But he knew their reasonings and said to the man having the withered hand: Rise and stand in the midst. And rising, he stood.

9 Therefore Jesus said to them: I shall question you: What is lawful on the Sabbath, to do good or to do evil, to save a soul or to destroy?

10 And looking around at them all, he said to the man: Stretch out your hand. And he did so, and his hand was restored healthy as the other.

11 But they were filled with madness and were discussing with one another what they might do to Jesus.

12 And it happened in these days, he went out into the mountain to pray, and was spending the night in prayer to God.

13 And when day came, he called his disciples to him, and chose twelve from them, whom he also named apostles:

14 Simon, whom he also named Peter, and Andrew his brother, James and John, Philip and Bartholomew,

15 Matthew and Thomas, James the son of Alphaeus, and Simon called Zealot,

16 Judas of James, and Judas Iscariot, who also became a betrayer.

17 And descending with them, he stood upon a level place, and a crowd of his disciples and a great multitude of the people from all Judea and Jerusalem and the coast of Tyre and Sidon, who came to hear him and be healed from their diseases,

18 and those troubled by unclean spirits, and they were being healed.

19 And the whole crowd was seeking to touch him, because power was coming out from him and healing all.

20 And he lifted his eyes toward his disciples and was saying: Blessed are the poor, because yours is the kingdom of God.

21 Blessed are those hungry now, because you shall be filled. Blessed are those weeping now, because you shall laugh.

22 Blessed are you when men hate you, and when they separate you and reproach and cast out your name as evil because of the Son of man.

23 Rejoice in that day and leap, for behold, your reward is great in the heaven; for according to these things their fathers were doing to the prophets.

24 Nevertheless, woe to you rich, because you have your consolation in full.

25 Woe to you who have been filled, because you shall hunger. Woe to you laughing now, because you shall mourn and weep.

26 Woe to you when all men speak well of you, for according to these things their fathers were doing to the false prophets.

27 But I say to you who hear: Love your enemies; do well to those who hate you;

28 bless those who curse you, and pray for those who mistreat you.

29 To the one striking you upon the cheek, offer the other also; and from the one taking your garment, do not withhold the tunic also.

30 And give to everyone asking you, and from the one taking your things, do not demand them back.

31 And as you wish men to do to you, you also do to them likewise.

32 And if you love those loving you, what grace is yours? For even sinners love those loving them.

33 And if you do good to those doing good to you, what grace is yours? For even sinners do the same.

34 And if you lend to those from whom you hope to receive back, what grace is yours? For even sinners lend to sinners to receive back equal things.

35 Nevertheless, love your enemies and do good and lend, despairing of nothing; and your reward shall be great, and you shall be sons of the Most High, because he is kind to the ungrateful and evil.

36 Therefore become compassionate, as your Father also is compassionate.

37 And do not judge, and you shall certainly not be judged; do not condemn, and you shall certainly not be condemned; release, and you shall be released.

38 Give, and it shall be given to you; a good measure, pressed down and shaken and overflowing, they shall give into your bosom; for with the same measure with which you measure, it shall be measured back to you.

39 And he told them a parable: Can a blind man guide a blind man? Shall not both fall into a pit?

40 A disciple is not above his teacher, but everyone fully prepared shall be as his teacher.

41 And why do you see the speck in your brother's eye, but do not consider the beam in your own eye?

42 Or how can you say to your brother: Brother, allow me to cast out the speck in your eye, yourself not seeing the beam in your eye? Hypocrite, first cast out the beam from your eye, and then you shall see clearly to cast out the speck in your brother's eye.

43 For there is no good tree producing rotten fruit, nor a rotten tree producing good fruit.

44 For each tree is known from its own fruit; for they do not gather figs from thorns, nor harvest a grape from a bramble.

45 The good man brings forth the good from the good treasure of his heart, and the evil man brings forth the evil from the evil treasure of his heart; for his mouth speaks from the abundance of the heart.

46 And why do you call me: Lord, Lord, and do not do what I say?

47 Everyone coming to me and hearing my words and doing them, I shall show you whom he is like.

48 He is like a man building a house, who dug and deepened and placed a foundation upon the rock; and when a flood came, the river broke against that house and was not strong enough to shake it, for it had been founded upon the rock.

49 But the one hearing and not doing is like a man who built a house upon the earth without a foundation, against which the river broke, and immediately it fell, and the collapse of that house became great.

Chapter 7

1 And when he fulfilled all his sayings in the hearing of the people, he entered into Capernaum.

2 And a certain centurion's slave, who was precious to him, was ill and about to die.

3 And hearing concerning Jesus, he sent elders of the Jews to him, asking him to come and save his slave.

4 And arriving at Jesus, they were begging him earnestly, saying: He is worthy for whom you shall grant this,

5 for he loves our nation, and he himself built the synagogue for us.

6 And Jesus was going with them; and already, when he was not far from the house, the centurion sent friends to him, saying to him: Lord, do not trouble yourself, for I am not sufficient that you enter under my roof.

7 Therefore neither did I deem myself worthy to come to you, but speak with a word, and my servant shall be healed.

8 For I also am a man placed under authority, having soldiers under myself, and I say to this one: Go, and he goes; and to another: Come, and he comes; and to my slave: Do this, and he does.

9 And Jesus heard these things and marveled at him, and turning to the crowd following him, said: I say to you, not even in Israel did I find such faith.

10 And those sent returned into the house and found the sick slave healthy.

11 And it happened on the next day, he was going into a city called Nain, and many of his disciples and a great crowd were going with him.

12 And when he drew near to the gate of the city, behold, a dead man was being carried out, the only son of his mother, and she was a widow; and a considerable crowd of the city was with her.

13 And the Lord saw her and had compassion on her and said to her: Do not weep.

14 And approaching, he touched the bier, and those carrying stood still; and he said: Young man, I say to you, rise.

15 And the dead man sat up and began to speak, and he gave him to his mother.

16 And fear took all, and they were glorifying God, saying: A great prophet has been raised among us; and: God visited his people.

17 And this word concerning him went out in the whole of Judea and in the whole surrounding region.

18 And his disciples reported to John concerning all these things.

19 And John called two of his disciples to him and sent to Jesus, saying: Are you the one coming, or do we await another?

20 And the men arrived at him and said: John the Baptist has sent us to you, saying: Are you the one coming, or do we await another?

21 And in that very hour he healed many from diseases and afflictions and evil spirits, and granted many blind people to see.

22 And Jesus answered and said to them: Go and report to John what you saw and heard: that blind people see again, lame people walk, lepers are cleansed, deaf people hear, dead people are raised, poor people receive good news.

23 And blessed is whoever is not made to stumble at me.

24 And when John's messengers went away, he began to say to the crowds concerning John: What have you gone out into the desert to behold? A reed shaken by wind?

25 But what have you gone out to see? A man clothed in soft garments? Behold, those living in glorious clothing and luxury are in the royal palaces.

26 But what have you gone out to see? A prophet? Yes, I say to you, and more than a prophet.

27 This is he concerning whom it is written: Behold, I send my messenger before your face, who shall prepare your way before you.

28 For I say to you: Among those born of women there is no prophet greater than John the Baptist, but the lesser in the kingdom of God is greater than he.

29 And all the people hearing, and the tax collectors, justified God, being baptized with John's baptism.

30 But the Pharisees and the lawyers rejected the counsel of God for themselves, not being baptized by him.

31 And the Lord said: To what, therefore, shall I liken the men of this generation, and what are they like?

32 They are like children sitting in a marketplace and calling to one another and saying: We played the flute for you and you did not dance; we lamented for you and you did not weep.

33 For John the Baptist has come neither eating bread nor drinking wine, and you say: He has a demon.

34 The Son of man has come eating and drinking, and you say: Behold, a gluttonous man and wine-drinker, a friend of tax collectors and sinners.

35 And wisdom was justified by all her children.

36 And one of the Pharisees was asking him to eat with him; and entering into the Pharisee's house, he reclined.

37 And behold, a woman in the city who was a sinner, recognizing that he reclines in the Pharisee's house, brought an alabaster vessel of ointment,

38 and standing behind at his feet, weeping, began to wet his feet with her tears, and was wiping them with the hairs of her head and kissing his feet fervently and anointing with the ointment.

39 And the Pharisee who invited him saw and said in himself, saying: If this man were a prophet, he would know who and what manner of woman touches him, that she is a sinner.

40 And Jesus answered and said to him: Simon, I have something to tell you. And he says: Teacher, speak.

41 A certain lender had two debtors; the one owed five hundred denarii, and the other fifty.

42 And as they had nothing to repay, he freely forgave both; therefore tell me, which of them shall love him more?

43 And Simon answered and said: I suppose the one to whom he forgave more. And he said to him: You judged correctly.

44 And turning to the woman, he said to Simon: Do you see this woman? I entered into your house; you gave no water for my feet, but she wet my feet with tears and wiped them with the hairs of her head.

45 You gave me no kiss, but she, from when I entered, did not cease kissing my feet fervently.

46 You did not anoint my head with oil, but she anointed my feet with ointment.

47 For which reason I say to you: Her many sins have been forgiven, because she loved much; but he to whom little is forgiven loves little.

48 And he said to her: Your sins have been forgiven.

49 And those reclining with him began to say among themselves: Who is this who even forgives sins?

50 And he said to the woman: Your faith has saved you; go into peace.

Chapter 8

1 And it happened afterward, he was traveling through city and village, proclaiming and announcing the kingdom of God, and the twelve with him,

2 and certain women who had been healed from evil spirits and illnesses: Mary called Magdalene, from whom seven demons had gone out,

3 and Joanna, wife of Chuza, Herod's steward, and Susanna and many others, who were serving him from their possessions.

4 And a great crowd was gathering, and those from each city were coming to him; he spoke through a parable:

5 The sower went out to sow his seed, and as he sowed, some fell beside the road and was trampled, and the birds of the heaven devoured it.

6 And other fell upon the rock, and growing, withered because it had no moisture.

7 And other fell in the midst of the thorns, and the thorns grew together and choked it.

8 And other fell upon the good earth, and growing, produced fruit a hundredfold. Saying these things, he was calling: He who has ears to hear, let him hear.

9 And his disciples were questioning him, saying what this parable might be.

10 And he said: To you it has been given to know the mysteries of the kingdom of God, but to the rest in parables, so that seeing they may not see, and hearing may not understand.

11 And this is the parable: The seed is the word of God.

12 And those beside the road are those hearing; then the devil comes and takes the word from their heart, so that they may not believe and be saved.

13 And those upon the rock, who, when they hear, receive the word with joy, and these have no root, who believe for a time and in a time of temptation depart.

14 And what fell into the thorns, these are those who heard, and going along are choked by cares and wealth and pleasures of life, and do not bring fruit to completion.

15 And what is in the good earth, these are those who, hearing the word in a beautiful and good heart, hold it and bear fruit in endurance.

16 And no one lighting a lamp covers it with a vessel or puts it beneath a bed, but sets it upon a lampstand, so that those entering may see the light.

17 For there is nothing hidden which shall not become manifest, nor concealed which shall not be known and come into the open.

18 Therefore see how you hear; for whoever has, to him it shall be given, and whoever does not have, even what he seems to have shall be taken from him.

19 And his mother and brothers arrived at him, and could not meet him because of the crowd.

20 And it was reported to him, saying: Your mother and brothers stand outside, wishing to see you.

21 And he answered and said to them: My mother and my brothers are these who hear the word of God and do it.

22 And it happened on one of the days, he entered into a boat, and his disciples, and said to them: Let us pass through to the other side of the lake. And they put out.

23 And while they sailed, he fell asleep, and a windstorm descended into the lake, and they were being filled and were in danger.

24 And approaching, they woke him, saying: Master, Master, we perish. And rising, he rebuked the wind and the surge of the water, and they ceased, and a calm came.

25 And he said to them: Where is your faith? And fearing, they marveled, saying to one another: Who, then, is this, that he commands even the winds and the water, and they obey him?

26 And they sailed down into the region of the Gadarenes, which is opposite Galilee.

27 And when he went out upon the earth, a certain man from the city met him, who had demons for considerable times and was not putting on a garment and was not remaining in a house, but in the tombs.

28 And seeing Jesus and crying out, he fell before him and said with a great voice: What is between me and you, Jesus, Son of the Most High God? I petition you, do not torture me.

29 For he was commanding the unclean spirit to come out from the man; for it had seized him many times, and he was bound with chains and shackles, being guarded; and tearing the bonds, he was being driven by the demon into the deserts.

30 And Jesus questioned him, saying: What is your name? And he said: Legion, because many demons entered into him.

31 And he was begging him not to command them to go away into the abyss.

32 And there was a herd of many pigs feeding in the mountain, and they were begging him to permit them to enter into those; and he permitted them.

33 And the demons came out from the man and entered into the pigs, and the herd rushed down the precipice into the lake and was drowned.

34 And those feeding saw what had happened and fled, and went and reported into the city and into the fields.

35 And they went out to see what has happened, and came to Jesus and found the man from whom the demons had gone out sitting clothed and in his right mind at Jesus' feet, and they feared.

36 And those who saw also reported to them how the demon-possessed man was saved.

37 And the whole multitude of the surrounding region of the Gadarenes asked him to go away from them, because they were held by great fear; and he entered into the boat and returned.

38 And the man from whom the demons had gone out was petitioning him to be with him; but Jesus dismissed him, saying:

39 Return into your house and recount how many things God did for you. And he went away, proclaiming throughout the whole city how many things Jesus did for him.

40 And it happened, when Jesus returned, the crowd received him, for all were awaiting him.

41 And behold, a man came named Jairus, and he was a ruler of the synagogue; and falling at Jesus' feet, he was begging him to enter into his house,

42 because he had an only daughter of about twelve years, and she was dying. And as he went, the crowds were choking him together.

43 And a woman being in a flow of blood for twelve years, who had spent her whole livelihood upon physicians, could not be healed by anyone,

44 approached from behind and touched the fringe of his garment, and immediately the flow of her blood stopped.

45 And Jesus said: Who touched me? And while all denied, Peter and those with him said: Master, the crowds hold you and press you, and you say: Who touched me?

46 But Jesus said: Someone touched me, for I knew power going out from me.

47 And the woman, seeing that she was not hidden, came trembling and fell before him and reported to him before all the people for what cause she touched him, and how she was healed immediately.

48 And he said to her: Take courage, daughter; your faith has saved you; go into peace.

49 While he was still speaking, someone comes from the synagogue ruler, saying to him: Your daughter has died; do not trouble the teacher.

50 But Jesus heard and answered him, saying: Do not fear; only believe, and she shall be saved.

51 And entering into the house, he allowed no one to enter except Peter and James and John, and the girl's father and mother.

52 And all were weeping and mourning her, but he said: Do not weep; she did not die, but sleeps.

53 And they were laughing at him, knowing that she died.

54 But he cast all outside and took hold of her hand and called, saying: Girl, rise.

55 And her spirit returned, and she rose immediately; and he directed that something be given her to eat.

56 And her parents were astonished, but he commanded them to tell no one what has happened.

Chapter 9

1 And calling his twelve disciples together, he gave them power and authority over all the demons, and to heal diseases.

2 And he sent them to proclaim the kingdom of God and heal the sick.

3 And he said to them: Take nothing for the road, neither staffs nor bag nor bread nor silver, nor have two tunics each.

4 And into whatever house you enter, remain there and go out from there.

5 And as many as do not receive you, going out from that city, shake off even the dust from your feet as a testimony against them.

6 And going out, they were passing through the villages, announcing good news and healing everywhere.

7 And Herod the tetrarch heard all the things happening by him, and was perplexed because some said that John has been raised from the dead,

8 and some that Elijah appeared, and others that one prophet of the ancients rose.

9 And Herod said: John I beheaded; but who is this concerning whom I hear such things? And he was seeking to see him.

10 And the apostles returned and recounted to him whatever they did; and taking them with him, he withdrew privately into a deserted place of a city called Bethsaida.

11 But the crowds knew and followed him; and receiving them, he was speaking to them concerning the kingdom of God and healing those having need of healing.

12 And the day began to decline, and the twelve approached and said to him: Dismiss the crowd so that they may go into the surrounding villages and fields and lodge and find provisions, because here we are in a deserted place.

13 And he said to them: You give them something to eat. And they said: We have no more than five loaves and two fish, unless we go and buy foods for all this people.

14 For they were about five thousand men. And he said to his disciples: Make them recline in reclining groups of fifty each.

15 And they did so and made all recline.

16 And taking the five loaves and the two fish, he looked up into the heaven and blessed them and broke them, and was giving to the disciples to set before the crowd.

17 And all ate and were filled, and what remained of fragments for them was taken up, twelve baskets.

18 And it happened while he was praying alone, the disciples were with him, and he questioned them, saying: Who do the crowds say that I am?

19 And they answered and said: John the Baptist; and others Elijah; and others that a certain prophet of the ancients rose.

20 And he said to them: But you, who do you say that I am? And Peter answered and said: The Christ of God.

21 And rebuking them, he commanded to tell no one this,

22 saying that the Son of man must suffer many things and be rejected by the elders and chief priests and scribes, and be killed, and on the third day be raised.

23 And he was saying to all: If anyone wishes to come behind me, let him deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow me.

24 For whoever wishes to save his soul shall lose it, but whoever loses his soul because of me, this one shall save it.

25 For what does a man profit, gaining the whole world but destroying himself or suffering loss?

26 For whoever is ashamed of me and my words, of this one the Son of man shall be ashamed when he comes in his glory and that of the Father and of the holy angels.

27 But I say to you truly: There are some standing here who shall certainly not taste death until they see the kingdom of God.

28 And it happened about eight days after these words, he took Peter and John and James with him and went up into the mountain to pray.

29 And it happened while he prayed, the appearance of his face was different, and his clothing white, flashing.

30 And behold, two men were conversing with him, who were Moses and Elijah,

31 who appeared in glory and were speaking of his departure which he was about to fulfill in Jerusalem.

32 But Peter and those with him were weighed down with sleep; and staying awake, they saw his glory and the two men standing with him.

33 And it happened as they were parting from him, Peter said to Jesus: Master, it is good for us to be here, and let us make three tents, one for you and one for Moses and one for Elijah, not knowing what he says.

34 And while he said these things, a cloud came and overshadowed them; and they feared as those entered into the cloud.

35 And a voice came from the cloud, saying: This is my beloved Son; hear him.

36 And when the voice came, Jesus was found alone; and they were silent and reported to no one in those days anything of what they have seen.

37 And it happened on the next day, when they descended from the mountain, a great crowd met him.

38 And behold, a man from the crowd cried aloud, saying: Teacher, I petition you, look upon my son, because he is my only child.

39 And behold, a spirit takes him, and suddenly he cries, and it convulses him with foam, and scarcely withdraws from him, crushing him.

40 And I petitioned your disciples to cast it out, and they could not.

41 And Jesus answered and said: O unbelieving and perverted generation, until when shall I be with you and bear with you? Bring your son here.

42 And while he still approached, the demon threw him down and convulsed him; but Jesus rebuked the unclean spirit and healed the boy and gave him back to his father.

43 And all were astonished at the majesty of God. And while all marveled at everything which Jesus did, he said to his disciples:

44 You, put these words into your ears, for the Son of man is about to be handed over into the hands of men.

45 But they did not understand this saying, and it was concealed from them so that they might not perceive it, and they feared to ask him concerning this saying.

46 And a reasoning entered among them, who might be greater of them.

47 But Jesus, seeing the reasoning of their heart, took a child and stood it beside himself,

48 and said to them: Whoever receives this child in my name receives me, and whoever receives me receives the one who sent me; for he who is lesser among all of you, this one shall be great.

49 And John answered and said: Master, we saw someone casting out the demons in your name, and we hindered him because he does not follow with us.

50 And Jesus said to him: Do not hinder, for he who is not against us is for us.

51 And it happened as the days of his taking up were being fulfilled, he set his face to go into Jerusalem,

52 and sent messengers before his face; and they went and entered into a village of Samaritans, to prepare for him.

53 And they did not receive him, because his face was going into Jerusalem.

54 And his disciples James and John saw and said: Lord, do you wish us to say that fire descend from the heaven and consume them, as Elijah also did?

55 But turning, he rebuked them and said: You do not know of what manner of spirit you are.

56 For the Son of man did not come to destroy men's souls, but to save. And they went into another village.

57 And it happened as they went on the road, someone said to him: I shall follow you wherever you go, Lord.

58 And Jesus said to him: The foxes have dens and the birds of the heaven dwelling places, but the Son of man has nowhere to lay his head.

59 And he said to another: Follow me. But he said: Lord, permit me first to go and bury my father.

60 And Jesus said to him: Leave the dead to bury their own dead, but you go and announce the kingdom of God.

61 And another also said: I shall follow you, Lord, but first permit me to take leave of those in my house.

62 And Jesus said to him: No one putting his hand upon a plow and looking backward is fit for the kingdom of God.

Chapter 10

1 And after these things the Lord appointed another seventy also and sent them two by two before his face into every city and place where he himself was about to come.

2 Therefore he was saying to them: The harvest indeed is great, but the workers few; therefore petition the Lord of the harvest to send out workers into his harvest.

3 Go; behold, I send you as lambs in the midst of wolves.

4 Do not carry a purse, nor bag, nor sandals, and greet no one along the road.

5 And into whatever house you enter, first say: Peace to this house.

6 And if a son of peace is there, your peace shall rest upon him; otherwise it shall return upon you.

7 And remain in the same house, eating and drinking the things from them, for the worker is worthy of his wage; do not move from house to house.

8 And into whatever city you enter and they receive you, eat the things set before you,

9 and heal the sick in it and say to them: The kingdom of God has drawn near upon you.

10 But into whatever city you enter and they do not receive you, go out into its streets and say:

11 Even the dust from your city which clung to us we wipe off for you; nevertheless know this, that the kingdom of God has drawn near upon you.

12 And I say to you that it shall be more bearable for Sodom in that day than for that city.

13 Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you, Bethsaida! Because if the mighty works which happened in you had happened in Tyre and Sidon, long ago they would have repented, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.

14 Nevertheless, it shall be more bearable for Tyre and Sidon in the judgment than for you.

15 And you, Capernaum, exalted until the heaven, shall be brought down until Hades.

16 He who hears you hears me, and he who rejects you rejects me, and he who rejects me rejects the one who sent me.

17 And the seventy returned with joy, saying: Lord, even the demons are subject to us in your name.

18 And he said to them: I was beholding Satan falling like lightning from the heaven.

19 Behold, I give you authority to tread upon serpents and scorpions and upon all the power of the enemy, and nothing shall certainly harm you.

20 Nevertheless, do not rejoice in this, that the spirits are subject to you, but rejoice rather that your names were written in the heavens.

21 In that very hour Jesus exulted in the spirit and said: I acknowledge you, Father, Lord of the heaven and the earth, because you hid these things from wise and understanding men and revealed them to infants; yes, Father, because so it became goodwill before you.

22 And turning to the disciples, he said: All things were handed over to me by my Father, and no one knows who the Son is except the Father, and who the Father is except the Son and whomever the Son wishes to reveal him to.

23 And turning to the disciples privately, he said: Blessed are the eyes seeing what you see.

24 For I say to you that many prophets and kings wished to see what you see and did not see, and to hear what you hear and did not hear.

25 And behold, a certain lawyer rose, testing him and saying: Teacher, doing what shall I inherit eternal life?

26 And he said to him: What is written in the law? How do you read?

27 And he answered and said: You shall love the Lord your God from your whole heart and from your whole soul and from your whole strength and from your whole mind, and your neighbor as yourself.

28 And he said to him: You answered correctly; do this and you shall live.

29 But wishing to justify himself, he said to Jesus: And who is my neighbor?

30 And Jesus took it up and said: A certain man was descending from Jerusalem into Jericho and fell among robbers, who stripped him and inflicted blows and went away, leaving him half dead.

31 And by coincidence a certain priest was descending on that road, and seeing him, passed by opposite.

32 And likewise also a Levite, coming to the place and seeing, passed by opposite.

33 But a certain Samaritan traveling came upon him, and seeing him, had compassion,

34 and approached and bound his wounds, pouring oil and wine; and mounting him upon his own beast, brought him into an inn and cared for him.

35 And on the next day, going out, he took out two denarii and gave them to the innkeeper and said to him: Care for him, and whatever you spend additionally, I shall repay you when I return.

36 Which, therefore, of these three seems to you to have become neighbor of the one who fell among the robbers?

37 And he said: The one who did mercy with him. Therefore Jesus said to him: Go, and you do likewise.

38 And it happened as they went, he entered into a certain village; and a certain woman named Martha received him into her house.

39 And she had a sister called Mary, who also sat at Jesus' feet and was hearing his word.

40 But Martha was distracted about much service; and standing by, she said: Lord, do you not care that my sister left me alone to serve? Therefore tell her to help me.

41 And Jesus answered and said to her: Martha, Martha, you are anxious and troubled about many things,

42 but there is need of one; and Mary chose the good portion, which shall not be taken away from her.

Chapter 11

1 And it happened while he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said to him: Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples.

2 And he said to them: When you pray, say: Our Father who is in the heavens, let your name be sanctified; let your kingdom come; let your will happen, as in heaven, also upon the earth.

3 Give us our daily bread day by day,

4 and forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone owing us; and do not bring us into temptation, but rescue us from the evil one.

5 And he said to them: Who of you shall have a friend and go to him at midnight and say to him: Friend, lend me three loaves,

6 because a friend of mine arrived at me from a journey, and I have nothing to set before him;

7 and that one answering from within says: Do not give me troubles; already the door has been shut, and my children are with me in the bed; I cannot rise and give you?

8 I say to you: Even if he shall not rise and give him because he is his friend, yet because of his shamelessness he shall rise and give him as many as he needs.

9 And I say to you: Ask, and it shall be given to you; seek, and you shall find; knock, and it shall be opened to you.

10 For everyone asking receives, and the one seeking finds, and to the one knocking it shall be opened.

11 And which father of you shall the son ask for bread, and he shall give him a stone? Or even a fish, and he shall give him a serpent instead of a fish?

12 Or even if he asks for an egg, shall he give him a scorpion?

13 Therefore, if you, being evil, know to give good gifts to your children, how much more shall the Father from heaven give the Holy Spirit to those asking him?

14 And he was casting out a demon, and it was mute; and it happened when the demon came out, the mute man spoke, and the crowds marveled.

15 But some of them said: By Beelzebul, ruler of the demons, he casts out the demons.

16 And others, testing, were seeking from him a sign from heaven.

17 But he knew their thoughts and said to them: Every kingdom divided against itself is desolated, and house falls upon house.

18 And if Satan also was divided against himself, how shall his kingdom stand? Because you say I cast out the demons by Beelzebul.

19 And if I cast out the demons by Beelzebul, by whom do your sons cast them out? For this reason they shall be your judges.

20 But if I cast out the demons by God's finger, then the kingdom of God has reached you.

21 When the strong man, fully armed, guards his own courtyard, his possessions are in peace.

22 But when one stronger than he comes upon him and conquers him, he takes away his full armor upon which he had trusted and distributes his spoils.

23 He who is not with me is against me, and he who does not gather with me scatters.

24 When the unclean spirit comes out from the man, it passes through waterless places seeking rest, and not finding, says: I shall return into my house from where I came out.

25 And coming, it finds it swept and adorned.

26 Then it goes and takes with it seven other spirits more evil than itself, and entering, they dwell there, and the last things of that man become worse than the first.

27 And it happened while he said these things, a certain woman lifted a voice from the crowd and said to him: Blessed is the womb which carried you and the breasts which you nursed.

28 But he said: Indeed rather, blessed are those hearing the word of God and keeping it.

29 And while the crowds gathered thickly, he began to say: This generation is evil; it seeks a sign, and a sign shall not be given it except the sign of Jonah the prophet.

30 For as Jonah became a sign to the Ninevites, so also shall the Son of man be to this generation.

31 The queen of the south shall be raised in the judgment with the men of this generation and shall condemn them, because she came from the ends of the earth to hear Solomon's wisdom; and behold, more than Solomon is here.

32 Men of Nineveh shall rise in the judgment with this generation and shall condemn it, because they repented at Jonah's proclamation; and behold, more than Jonah is here.

33 And no one lighting a lamp places it in a hidden place nor under the bushel, but upon the lampstand, so that those entering may see the light.

34 The lamp of the body is the eye; therefore when your eye is single, your whole body also is bright; but when it is evil, your body also is dark.

35 Therefore watch lest the light in you is darkness.

36 Therefore, if your whole body is bright, not having any dark part, it shall be wholly bright, as when the lamp lights you with its brightness.

37 And while he spoke, a certain Pharisee was asking him to dine with him; and entering, he reclined.

38 And the Pharisee saw and marveled that he did not first wash before the meal.

39 And the Lord said to him: Now you Pharisees cleanse the outside of the cup and the platter, but your inside is full of plunder and wickedness.

40 Fools, did not the one making the outside make the inside also?

41 Nevertheless, give the things within as alms, and behold, everything is clean for you.

42 But woe to you Pharisees, because you tithe the mint and the rue and every garden plant, and pass by judgment and the love of God; these you ought to have done, and not leave those.

43 Woe to you Pharisees, because you love the first seat in the synagogues and the greetings in the marketplaces.

44 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees, hypocrites, because you are like the unmarked tombs, and the men walking above do not know.

45 And one of the lawyers answered and says to him: Teacher, saying these things, you insult us also.

46 And he said: Woe to you lawyers also, because you load men with burdens hard to bear, and you yourselves do not touch the burdens with one of your fingers.

47 Woe to you, because you build the monuments of the prophets, but your fathers killed them.

48 Therefore you testify and approve the works of your fathers, because they indeed killed them, but you build their monuments.

49 For this reason the wisdom of God also said: I shall send to them prophets and apostles, and some of them they shall kill and persecute,

50 so that the blood of all the prophets, poured out from the foundation of the world, may be demanded from this generation,

51 from Abel's blood until the blood of Zechariah, who perished between the altar and the house; yes, I say to you, it shall be demanded from this generation.

52 Woe to you lawyers, because you took away the key of knowledge; you yourselves did not enter, and you hindered those entering.

53 And while he said these things to them, the scribes and the Pharisees began to hold fiercely against him and question him about more things,

54 lying in wait for him and seeking to catch something out of his mouth so that they might accuse him.

Chapter 12

1 Meanwhile, when the myriads of the crowd gathered together, so that they trampled one another, he began to say first to his disciples: Beware for yourselves of the leaven of the Pharisees, which is hypocrisy.

2 And there is nothing covered which shall not be revealed, and hidden which shall not be known.

3 Therefore whatever you said in the darkness shall be heard in the light, and what you spoke to the ear in the inner rooms shall be proclaimed upon the roofs.

4 And I say to you my friends: Do not fear those killing the body and after these things having nothing further to do.

5 But I shall show you whom to fear: Fear the one who after killing has authority to cast into Gehenna; yes, I say to you, fear this one.

6 Are not five sparrows sold for two assaria? And one of them is not forgotten before God.

7 But even all the hairs of your head have been numbered; therefore do not fear, you surpass many sparrows.

8 And I say to you: Everyone who acknowledges me before men, the Son of man also shall acknowledge him before the angels of God.

9 But the one denying me before men shall be denied before the angels of God.

10 And everyone who shall speak a word against the Son of man, it shall be forgiven him, but to the one blaspheming against the Holy Spirit it shall not be forgiven.

11 And when they bring you before the synagogues and the rulers and the authorities, do not be anxious how or what to answer in defense, or what to say,

12 for the Holy Spirit shall teach you in that very hour what must be said.

13 And someone from the crowd said to him: Teacher, tell my brother to divide the inheritance with me.

14 But he said to him: Man, who appointed me judge or divider over you?

15 And he said to them: See and guard yourselves from greed, because a man's life is not in his abundance from his possessions.

16 And he told them a parable, saying: The land of a certain rich man bore plentifully,

17 and he was reasoning in himself, saying: What shall I do, because I have nowhere to gather my fruits?

18 And he said: I shall do this: I shall take down my storehouses and build greater ones, and gather there all my produce and my goods.

19 And I shall say to my soul: Soul, you have many goods laid up for many years; rest, eat, drink, rejoice.

20 But God said to him: Fool, in this night they demand your soul from you; and what you prepared, whose shall it be?

21 So is the one storing treasure for himself and not being rich toward God.

22 And he said to his disciples: For this reason I say to you: Do not be anxious for your soul, what to eat, nor for the body, what to put on.

23 The soul is more than food, and the body than the garment.

24 Consider the ravens, that they neither sow nor harvest, which have neither storeroom nor storehouse, and God feeds them; how much more do you surpass the birds!

25 And which of you, being anxious, can add one cubit to his stature?

26 Therefore, if you cannot do even the least, why are you anxious concerning the rest?

27 Consider the lilies, how they grow; they neither labor nor spin; but I say to you, not even Solomon in all his glory was clothed as one of these.

28 But if God so clothes the grass in the field, being today and tomorrow cast into an oven, how much more you, you of little faith!

29 And you, do not seek what to eat or what to drink, and do not be unsettled.

30 For the nations of the world seek all these things, but your Father knows that you need these.

31 Nevertheless, seek the kingdom of God, and all these things shall be added to you.

32 Do not fear, little flock, because your Father was well pleased to give you the kingdom.

33 Sell your possessions and give alms; make for yourselves purses not growing old, unfailing treasure in the heavens, where a thief does not draw near nor a moth destroy.

34 For where your treasure is, there your heart also shall be.

35 Let your waists be girded and the lamps burning,

36 and you like men awaiting their own lord, when he returns from the wedding feast, so that when he comes and knocks, they may immediately open to him.

37 Blessed are those slaves whom the lord, coming, shall find keeping watch; amen, I say to you that he shall gird himself and make them recline, and come and serve them.

38 And if he comes in the second watch, and comes in the third watch, and finds so, blessed are those slaves.

39 And know this, that if the master of the house had known at what hour the thief comes, he would have kept watch and would not have allowed his house to be dug through.

40 Therefore you also become ready, because at an hour you do not think, the Son of man comes.

41 And Peter said to him: Lord, do you say this parable to us, or also to all?

42 And the Lord said: Who, then, is the faithful and prudent steward whom the lord shall appoint over his household to give the grain ration in season?

43 Blessed is that slave whom his lord, coming, shall find doing so.

44 Truly I say to you that he shall appoint him over all his possessions.

45 But if that slave says in his heart: My lord delays coming, and begins to beat the male servants and the female servants, and to eat and drink and be drunk,

46 the lord of that slave shall come on a day which he does not expect and at an hour which he does not know, and shall cut him in two and place his portion with the unbelievers.

47 And that slave who knew his own lord's will and did not prepare nor do according to his will shall be beaten with many blows.

48 But the one not knowing, but doing things worthy of blows, shall be beaten with few; and from everyone to whom much was given, much shall be sought, and from the one to whom they entrusted much, they shall ask more.

49 I came to cast fire into the earth, and what do I wish if it was already kindled!

50 But I have a baptism to be baptized with, and how I am held until it is completed!

51 Do you think that I came to give peace on the earth? No, I say to you, but rather division.

52 For from now five in one house shall be divided, three against two and two against three.

53 Father shall be divided against son and son against father, mother against daughter and daughter against mother, mother-in-law against her daughter-in-law and daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law.

54 And he also was saying to the crowds: When you see the cloud rising from the west, immediately you say: A rainstorm comes, and it happens so.

55 And when a south wind blows, you say that there shall be scorching heat, and it happens.

56 Hypocrites, you know to examine the face of the earth and the heaven, but how do you not examine this time?

57 And why do you not also judge what is just from yourselves?

58 For as you go with your adversary before a ruler, on the road give effort to be released from him, lest he drag you to the judge, and the judge hand you over to the officer, and the officer cast you into prison.

59 I say to you: You shall certainly not come out from there until you repay even the last lepton.

Chapter 13

1 And some were present at that very time, reporting to him concerning the Galileans whose blood Pilate mixed with their sacrifices.

2 And Jesus answered and said to them: Do you think that these Galileans became sinners beyond all the Galileans because they have suffered such things?

3 No, I say to you, but unless you repent, you shall all likewise perish.

4 Or those eighteen upon whom the tower in Siloam fell and killed them, do you think that these became debtors beyond all men dwelling in Jerusalem?

5 No, I say to you, but unless you repent, you shall all similarly perish.

6 And he was telling this parable: Someone had a fig tree planted in his vineyard, and came seeking fruit on it and did not find.

7 And he said to the vine dresser: Behold, three years I come seeking fruit on this fig tree and do not find; cut it down; why does it also render the earth idle?

8 And he answered and says to him: Lord, leave it this year also, until I dig around it and put manure,

9 and if it produces fruit; but otherwise, in the future you shall cut it down.

10 And he was teaching in one of the synagogues on the Sabbath.

11 And behold, there was a woman having a spirit of illness eighteen years, and she was bent together and unable to straighten up completely.

12 And Jesus saw her and called her and said to her: Woman, you have been released from your illness.

13 And he laid his hands upon her, and immediately she was straightened and was glorifying God.

14 But the synagogue ruler answered, indignant because Jesus healed on the Sabbath, and was saying to the crowd: There are six days in which one must work; therefore come and be healed in these, and not on the Sabbath day.

15 Therefore the Lord answered him and said: Hypocrite, does not each of you on the Sabbath loose his ox or donkey from the manger and lead it away and give it to drink?

16 But this woman, being Abraham's daughter, whom Satan bound, behold, eighteen years, ought she not to be loosed from this bond on the Sabbath day?

17 And while he said these things, all those opposing him were being put to shame, and the whole crowd was rejoicing over all the glorious things happening by him.

18 And he was saying: What is the kingdom of God like, and to what shall I liken it?

19 It is like a grain of mustard which a man took and cast into his own garden, and it grew and became a great tree, and the birds of the heaven dwelt in its branches.

20 And again he said: To what shall I liken the kingdom of God?

21 It is like leaven which a woman took and hid in three sata of flour, until the whole was leavened.

22 And he was passing through cities and villages, teaching and making a journey into Jerusalem.

23 And someone said to him: Lord, are those being saved few? And he said to them:

24 Struggle to enter through the narrow gate, because many, I say to you, shall seek to enter and shall not be strong enough.

25 From when the master of the house rises and shuts the door, and you begin to stand outside and knock at the door, saying: Lord, Lord, open to us, he shall answer and say to you: I do not know you, from where you are.

26 Then you shall begin to say: We ate and drank before you, and you taught in our streets.

27 And he shall say: I say to you, I do not know you, from where you are; depart from me, all workers of unrighteousness.

28 There shall be the weeping and the grinding of teeth, when you see Abraham and Isaac and Jacob and all the prophets in the kingdom of God, but yourselves being cast outside.

29 And they shall come from east and west and from north and south, and shall recline in the kingdom of God.

30 And behold, there are last who shall be first, and there are first who shall be last.

31 In that very day some Pharisees approached, saying to him: Go out and depart from here, because Herod wishes to kill you.

32 And he said to them: Go and tell this fox: Behold, I cast out demons and complete healings today and tomorrow, and on the third I am completed.

33 Nevertheless I must go today and tomorrow and the following day, because it is not possible for a prophet to perish outside Jerusalem.

34 Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the prophets and stones those sent to her, how often I wished to gather your children together in the manner that a hen gathers her own brood under the wings, and you were unwilling!

35 Behold, your house is left to you deserted; and amen, I say to you that you shall certainly not see me until it comes when you say: Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord.

Chapter 14

1 And it happened when he came into the house of one of the rulers of the Pharisees on a Sabbath to eat bread, they were watching him.

2 And behold, a certain man with dropsy was before him.

3 And Jesus answered and said to the lawyers and Pharisees, saying: Is it lawful to heal on the Sabbath?

4 But they were quiet; and taking hold of him, he healed him and released him.

5 And answering them, he said: Whose donkey or ox of you shall fall into a well, and he shall not immediately pull it up on the Sabbath day?

6 And they were not strong enough to answer him concerning these things.

7 And he was telling a parable to those invited, observing how they chose the first reclining places, saying to them:

8 When you are invited by someone to a wedding feast, do not recline in the first reclining place, lest someone more honored than you has been invited by him,

9 and the one inviting you and him comes and shall say to you: Give this one a place; and then you shall begin with shame to occupy the last place.

10 But when you are invited, go and recline in the last place, so that when the one inviting you comes, he may say to you: Friend, come up higher; then you shall have glory before those reclining with you.

11 Because everyone exalting himself shall be humbled, and the one humbling himself shall be exalted.

12 And he also was saying to the one inviting him: When you make a meal or supper, do not call your friends nor your brothers nor your relatives nor rich neighbors, lest they also invite you back and a repayment come to you.

13 But when you make a reception, invite poor, crippled, lame, blind people,

14 and you shall be blessed, because they have nothing to repay you, for it shall be repaid you in the resurrection of the righteous.

15 And one of those reclining with him heard these things and said to him: Blessed is whoever shall eat bread in the kingdom of God.

16 And he said to him: A certain man made a great supper and invited many,

17 and sent his slave at the hour of the supper to tell those invited: Come, because everything is already ready.

18 And all began from one accord to excuse themselves; the first said to him: I bought a field and have necessity to go out and see it; I ask you, hold me excused.

19 And another said: I bought five pairs of oxen and go to examine them; I ask you, hold me excused.

20 And another said: I married a wife, and for this reason I cannot come.

21 And that slave arrived and reported these things to his lord; then the master of the house became angry and said to his slave: Go out quickly into the streets and lanes of the city, and bring here the poor and crippled and lame and blind.

22 And the slave said: Lord, it has happened as you commanded, and there is still room.

23 And the lord said to the slave: Go out into the roads and fences and compel them to enter, so that my house may be filled.

24 For I say to you that none of those men invited shall taste my supper.

25 And many crowds were going with him, and turning, he said to them:

26 If anyone comes to me and does not hate his own father and mother and wife and children and brothers and sisters, and further even his own soul, he cannot be my disciple.

27 And whoever does not carry his cross and come behind me cannot be my disciple.

28 For which of you, wishing to build a tower, does not first sit and calculate the expense, whether he has the things for completion,

29 lest when he has placed a foundation and is not strong enough to finish, all who behold begin to mock him,

30 saying: This man began to build and was not strong enough to finish?

31 Or what king, going to meet another king in war, does not first sit and take counsel whether he is able with ten thousand to meet the one coming against him with twenty thousand?

32 Otherwise, while he is still far off, he sends an embassy and asks the things for peace.

33 So therefore everyone of you who does not take leave of all his own possessions cannot be my disciple.

34 The salt is good, but if the salt becomes tasteless, with what shall it be seasoned?

35 It is fit neither for earth nor for manure; they cast it outside. He who has ears to hear, let him hear.

Chapter 15

1 And all the tax collectors and sinners were drawing near to him to hear him.

2 And the Pharisees and scribes were grumbling, saying: This man receives sinners and eats with them.

3 And he told them this parable, saying:

4 What man of you, having a hundred sheep and losing one of them, does not leave the ninety-nine in the desert and go after the lost one until he finds it?

5 And finding, he places it upon his own shoulders, rejoicing.

6 And coming into the house, he calls together the friends and neighbors, saying to them: Rejoice with me, because I found my sheep which was lost.

7 I say to you that so there shall be joy in the heaven over one sinner repenting, rather than over ninety-nine righteous men who have no need of repentance.

8 Or what woman having ten drachmas, if she loses one drachma, does not light a lamp and sweep the house and seek diligently until she finds?

9 And finding, she calls together the female friends and neighbors, saying: Rejoice with me, because I found the drachma which I lost.

10 So, I say to you, joy happens before the angels of God over one sinner repenting.

11 And he said: A certain man had two sons,

12 and the younger of them said to the father: Father, give me the portion of the property falling to me. And he divided the livelihood for them.

13 And after not many days, the younger son gathered everything and went abroad into a distant region, and there scattered his property, living wastefully.

14 And when he spent everything, a strong famine came throughout that region, and he began to lack.

15 And going, he joined himself to one of the citizens of that region, and he sent him into his fields to feed pigs.

16 And he was desiring to fill his belly from the pods which the pigs ate, and no one was giving to him.

17 And coming to himself, he said: How many hired men of my father abound in loaves, but I perish with famine!

18 I shall rise and go to my father and say to him: Father, I sinned against the heaven and before you,

19 and I am no longer worthy to be called your son; make me as one of your hired men.

20 And rising, he came to his own father; but while he was still far off, his father saw him and had compassion, and ran and fell upon his neck and kissed him fervently.

21 And the son said to him: Father, I sinned against the heaven and before you, and I am no longer worthy to be called your son.

22 But the father said to his slaves: Bring out the first robe and clothe him, and give a ring onto his hand and sandals onto his feet,

23 and bring the fattened calf and slaughter it, and let us eat and rejoice,

24 because this son of mine was dead and lived again, and was lost and was found. And they began to rejoice.

25 And his elder son was in a field, and as he came and drew near to the house, he heard music and dancing,

26 and calling one of his servants, he was inquiring what these things might be.

27 And he said to him: Your brother has come, and your father slaughtered the fattened calf, because he received him back healthy.

28 But he became angry and was unwilling to enter; therefore his father went out and was begging him.

29 But he answered and said to the father: Behold, so many years I slave for you, and never passed by your commandment, and you never gave me a young goat so that I might rejoice with my friends.

30 But when this son of yours came, who devoured your livelihood with prostitutes, you slaughtered the fattened calf for him.

31 And he said to him: Child, you are always with me, and all my things are yours.

32 But it was necessary to rejoice and be glad, because this brother of yours was dead and lived again, and was lost and was found.

Chapter 16

1 And he was also saying to his disciples, A certain man was rich, who had a steward, and this man was accused before him of scattering his possessions.

2 And having called him, he said to him, What is this I hear about you? Give the account of your stewardship, for you will no longer be able to act as steward.

3 And the steward said within himself, What shall I do, because my master is taking the stewardship away from me? I am not strong enough to dig; I am ashamed to beg.

4 I know what I shall do, so that when I am removed from the stewardship, they may receive me into their houses.

5 And having summoned each one of his master's debtors, he was saying to the first, How much do you owe my master?

6 And he said, A hundred baths of oil. And he said to him, Take your document, and having sat down, quickly write fifty.

7 Then he said to another, And how much do you owe? And he said, A hundred cors of wheat. And he says to him, Take your document and write eighty.

8 And the master praised the steward of unrighteousness because he had acted prudently, because the sons of this age are more prudent toward their own generation than the sons of the light.

9 And I say to you, Make friends for yourselves from the mammon of unrighteousness, so that when you fail, they may receive you into the eternal tents.

10 The one faithful in the least is faithful also in much, and the one unrighteous in the least is unrighteous also in much.

11 If therefore you did not become faithful in unrighteous mammon, who will entrust the true thing to you?

12 And if you did not become faithful in what belongs to another, who will give you what is yours?

13 No household servant can serve two masters, for either he will hate the one and love the other, or he will hold to one and despise the other. You cannot serve God and mammon.

14 And the Pharisees, being lovers of money, were also hearing all these things, and were sneering at him.

15 And he said to them, You are those who justify yourselves before people, but God knows your hearts, because what is exalted among people is an abomination before God.

16 The law and the prophets were until John. From then the kingdom of God is proclaimed as good news, and everyone forces his way into it.

17 But it is easier for heaven and earth to pass away than for one stroke of the law to fall.

18 Everyone who dismisses his wife and marries another commits adultery, and everyone who marries a woman dismissed from a husband commits adultery.

19 And a certain man was rich, and was dressing in purple and fine linen, rejoicing splendidly every day.

20 And there was a certain poor man named Lazarus, who had been laid at his gateway, covered with sores,

21 and desiring to be filled from the crumbs falling from the rich man's table. But even the dogs, coming, were licking his sores.

22 And it happened that the poor man died and was carried away by the angels into Abraham's bosom. And the rich man also died and was buried.

23 And in Hades, having lifted up his eyes, being in torments, he sees Abraham from far away and Lazarus in his bosom.

24 And having called out, he said, Father Abraham, have mercy on me, and send Lazarus so that he may dip the tip of his finger in water and cool my tongue, because I am in anguish in this flame.

25 But Abraham said, Child, remember that you received your good things in your life, and Lazarus likewise the bad things. But now he is comforted, and you are in anguish.

26 And besides all these things, between us and you a great chasm has been fixed, so that those wishing to cross from here to you cannot, nor may those from there cross over to us.

27 And he said, I ask you therefore, father, that you send him to my father's house,

28 for I have five brothers, so that he may testify solemnly to them, so that they too may not come into this place of torment.

29 Abraham says to him, They have Moses and the prophets; let them hear them.

30 And he said, No, father Abraham, but if someone from the dead goes to them, they will repent.

31 But he said to him, If they do not hear Moses and the prophets, neither will they be persuaded if someone rises from the dead.

Chapter 17

1 And he said to the disciples, It is impossible for stumbling blocks not to come, but woe to him through whom they come.

2 It is better for him if a donkey millstone is placed around his neck and he is thrown into the sea than that he cause one of these little ones to stumble.

3 Pay attention to yourselves. And if your brother sins against you, rebuke him; and if he repents, forgive him.

4 And if he sins against you seven times in the day, and seven times in the day turns back to you, saying, I repent, you shall forgive him.

5 And the apostles said to the Lord, Add faith to us.

6 And the Lord said, If you had faith as a mustard seed, you would say to this mulberry tree, Be uprooted and be planted in the sea, and it would obey you.

7 And which of you, having a slave plowing or tending a flock, will say to him when he has come in from the field, Immediately come over and recline?

8 But will he not say to him, Prepare what I shall dine on, and having girded yourself, serve me until I eat and drink, and after these things you shall eat and drink?

9 Does he have gratitude to that slave because he did the things commanded him? I do not think so.

10 Thus also you, when you have done all the things commanded you, say, We are useless slaves, because we have done what we owed to do.

11 And it happened as he was going to Jerusalem that he was passing through the midst of Samaria and Galilee.

12 And as he was entering a certain village, ten leprous men met him, who stood far away.

13 And they raised their voice, saying, Jesus, Master, have mercy on us.

14 And having seen them, he said to them, Go and show yourselves to the priests. And it happened that as they were going, they were cleansed.

15 And one of them, having seen that he was healed, returned, glorifying God with a loud voice.

16 And he fell on his face at his feet, giving thanks to him. And he was a Samaritan.

17 And answering, Jesus said, Were not the ten cleansed? But where are the nine?

18 Were none found who returned to give glory to God except this foreigner?

19 And he said to him, Rise and go; your faith has saved you.

20 And having been asked by the Pharisees when the kingdom of God comes, he answered them and said, The kingdom of God does not come with observation.

21 Nor will they say, Look, here, or, Look, there; for look, the kingdom of God is within you.

22 And he said to the disciples, Days will come when you will desire to see one of the days of the Son of Man, and you will not see it.

23 And they will say to you, Look, here, or, Look, there. Do not go away, nor pursue.

24 For just as the lightning, flashing from one place under heaven, shines to another under heaven, so also will the Son of Man be in his day.

25 But first he must suffer many things and be rejected by this generation.

26 And just as it happened in the days of Noah, so also will it be in the days of the Son of Man.

27 They were eating, drinking, marrying, being given in marriage, until the day Noah entered the ark, and the flood came and destroyed them all.

28 Likewise also, as it happened in the days of Lot, they were eating, drinking, buying, selling, planting, building.

29 But on the day Lot went out from Sodom, it rained fire and sulfur from heaven and destroyed them all.

30 It will be according to these things on the day the Son of Man is revealed.

31 On that day, whoever will be on the housetop, and his goods in the house, let him not go down to take them; and the one in the field, likewise let him not turn back to the things behind.

32 Remember Lot's wife.

33 Whoever seeks to save his life will lose it, and whoever loses it will preserve it alive.

34 I say to you, On this night two will be on one bed; the one will be taken along, and the other will be left.

35 Two women will be grinding together; one will be taken along, and the other will be left.

36

37 And answering, they say to him, Where, Lord? And he said to them, Where the body is, there the eagles will be gathered.

Chapter 18

1 And he was also telling them a parable about the necessity of always praying and not losing heart,

2 saying, A certain judge was in a certain city, not fearing God and not respecting a person.

3 And a widow was in that city, and was coming to him, saying, Give me justice against my adversary.

4 And he was unwilling for a time. But after these things he said within himself, Even though I do not fear God and do not respect a person,

5 yet because this widow causes me trouble, I will give her justice, so that by coming continually she may not strike me under the eye.

6 And the Lord said, Hear what the judge of unrighteousness says.

7 And will God not give justice to his chosen ones, who cry to him day and night, and be patient over them?

8 I say to you that he will give them justice quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?

9 And he also told this parable to certain people who trusted in themselves that they were righteous and despised the rest:

10 Two men went up into the temple to pray, the one a Pharisee and the other a tax collector.

11 The Pharisee, having stood, was praying these things to himself, God, I thank you that I am not as the rest of people, rapacious, unrighteous, adulterers, or even as this tax collector.

12 I fast twice in the week; I give a tenth of all that I acquire.

13 And the tax collector, standing far away, was unwilling even to lift his eyes to heaven, but was striking his chest, saying, God, be propitious to me, the sinner.

14 I say to you, This man went down to his house justified rather than that man, because everyone who exalts himself will be humbled, but the one who humbles himself will be exalted.

15 And they were also bringing the infants to him so that he might touch them. But having seen it, the disciples rebuked them.

16 But Jesus, having called them to him, said, Allow the children to come to me, and do not hinder them, for of such is the kingdom of God.

17 Amen, I say to you, Whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a child will certainly not enter into it.

18 And a certain ruler asked him, saying, Good teacher, having done what shall I inherit eternal life?

19 And Jesus said to him, Why do you call me good? No one is good except one, God.

20 You know the commandments: Do not commit adultery; do not murder; do not steal; do not bear false witness; honor your father and your mother.

21 And he said, All these things I have kept from my youth.

22 And having heard these things, Jesus said to him, One thing still is lacking to you. Sell all that you have and distribute to the poor, and you will have treasure in heaven; and come, follow me.

23 But having heard these things, he became deeply sorrowful, for he was exceedingly rich.

24 And Jesus, having seen him become deeply sorrowful, said, How difficultly those having wealth will enter into the kingdom of God!

25 For it is easier for a camel to enter through a needle's hole than for a rich man to enter into the kingdom of God.

26 And those who heard said, And who can be saved?

27 And he said, The things impossible with people are possible with God.

28 And Peter said, Look, we left everything and followed you.

29 And he said to them, Amen, I say to you that there is no one who left a house or parents or brothers or a wife or children for the sake of the kingdom of God,

30 who will not certainly receive many times more in this time, and in the coming age eternal life.

31 And having taken the twelve along, he said to them, Look, we are going up to Jerusalem, and all the things written through the prophets concerning the Son of Man will be completed.

32 For he will be handed over to the nations, and will be mocked and insulted and spat upon.

33 And having scourged him, they will kill him, and on the third day he will rise.

34 And they understood none of these things, and this saying was hidden from them, and they did not know the things being said.

35 And it happened as he was drawing near to Jericho that a certain blind man was sitting beside the road, begging.

36 And having heard a crowd passing through, he was asking what this might be.

37 And they reported to him that Jesus the Nazarene was passing by.

38 And he cried out, saying, Jesus, Son of David, have mercy on me.

39 And those going ahead were rebuking him so that he would be silent, but he was crying out much more, Son of David, have mercy on me.

40 And having stood still, Jesus commanded him to be brought to him. And when he had drawn near, he asked him,

41 saying, What do you wish me to do for you? And he said, Lord, that I may see again.

42 And Jesus said to him, See again; your faith has saved you.

43 And immediately he saw again, and was following him, glorifying God; and all the people, having seen it, gave praise to God.

Chapter 19

1 And having entered, he was passing through Jericho.

2 And look, a man called by the name Zacchaeus, and he was a chief tax collector, and he was rich.

3 And he was seeking to see Jesus, who he is, and could not because of the crowd, because he was small in stature.

4 And having run ahead, he climbed up onto a sycamore tree so that he might see him, because he was about to pass through that way.

5 And when he came to the place, Jesus, having looked up, saw him and said to him, Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for today I must stay in your house.

6 And having hurried, he came down and received him joyfully.

7 And having seen it, all were murmuring, saying that he went in to lodge with a sinful man.

8 But Zacchaeus, having stood, said to the Lord, Look, half of my possessions, Lord, I give to the poor, and if I extorted anything from anyone, I repay fourfold.

9 And Jesus said to him, Today salvation has come to this house, because he too is a son of Abraham.

10 For the Son of Man came to seek and to save what was lost.

11 And while they were hearing these things, he added and told a parable, because he was near Jerusalem and they supposed that the kingdom of God was about to appear immediately.

12 He said therefore, A certain man of noble birth went into a distant country to receive a kingdom for himself and to return.

13 And having called ten slaves of his, he gave them ten minas and said to them, Do business until I come.

14 But his citizens hated him, and sent a delegation after him, saying, We do not wish this man to reign over us.

15 And it happened when he returned, having received the kingdom, that he said that these slaves to whom he gave the silver should be called to him, so that he might know what each had gained by business.

16 And the first came, saying, Master, your mina gained ten minas.

17 And he said to him, Well done, good slave. Because you became faithful in the least, have authority over ten cities.

18 And the second came, saying, Master, your mina made five minas.

19 And he said also to this one, And you, be over five cities.

20 And another came, saying, Master, look, your mina, which I had laid away in a handkerchief.

21 For I feared you because you are a severe man. You take up what you did not lay down, and reap what you did not sow.

22 And he says to him, From your mouth I will judge you, wicked slave. You knew that I am a severe man, taking up what I did not lay down and reaping what I did not sow.

23 And why did you not give my silver to the bank, and I, having come, would have collected it with interest?

24 And he said to those standing by, Take the mina from him and give it to the one having the ten minas.

25 And they said to him, Master, he has ten minas.

26 For I say to you that to everyone having, it will be given, but from the one not having, even what he has will be taken from him.

27 Nevertheless, those enemies of mine who did not wish me to reign over them, bring here and slaughter before me.

28 And having said these things, he was going ahead, going up to Jerusalem.

29 And it happened when he drew near to Bethphage and Bethany, toward the mountain called Olives, that he sent two of his disciples,

30 saying, Go into the village opposite, in which, entering, you will find a colt tied, on which no person ever sat. Having untied it, bring it.

31 And if anyone asks you, Why do you untie it? thus you shall say to him, The Lord has need of it.

32 And those sent, having gone away, found it just as he said to them.

33 And as they were untying the colt, its owners said to them, Why do you untie the colt?

34 And they said, The Lord has need of it.

35 And they brought it to Jesus, and having thrown their own garments upon the colt, they mounted Jesus on it.

36 And as he was going, they were spreading their garments in the road.

37 And as he was already drawing near to the descent of the Mount of Olives, the whole multitude of the disciples began rejoicing to praise God with a loud voice concerning all the mighty works they had seen,

38 saying, Blessed is the King who comes in the name of the Lord. Peace in heaven, and glory in the highest.

39 And some of the Pharisees from the crowd said to him, Teacher, rebuke your disciples.

40 And answering, he said to them, I say to you that if these are silent, the stones will cry out.

41 And when he drew near, having seen the city, he wept over it,

42 saying, If you too had known, even in this your day, the things for your peace! But now they were hidden from your eyes.

43 Because days will come upon you, and your enemies will throw a rampart around you, and will surround you and hem you in from every side,

44 and will dash you to the ground, and your children within you, and will not leave in you a stone upon a stone, because you did not know the time of your visitation.

45 And having entered into the temple, he began to cast out those selling in it and buying,

46 saying to them, It is written, My house is a house of prayer, but you made it a cave of robbers.

47 And he was teaching daily in the temple. But the chief priests and the scribes were seeking to destroy him, and the foremost of the people.

48 And they were not finding what they might do, for all the people were hanging upon him, listening.

Chapter 20

1 And it happened on one of those days, as he was teaching the people in the temple and proclaiming good news, that the chief priests and the scribes came upon him with the elders.

2 And they spoke to him, saying, Tell us by what authority you do these things, or who is the one who gave you this authority?

3 And answering, he said to them, I too will ask you one matter, and tell me:

4 Was the baptism of John from heaven or from people?

5 And they reasoned together among themselves, saying, If we say, From heaven, he will say, Why then did you not believe him?

6 But if we say, From people, all the people will stone us to death, for they are persuaded that John is a prophet.

7 And they answered that they did not know from where.

8 And Jesus said to them, Neither do I tell you by what authority I do these things.

9 And he began to tell this parable to the people: A certain man planted a vineyard, and leased it to farmers, and went abroad for a considerable time.

10 And at the season he sent a slave to the farmers so that they might give him from the fruit of the vineyard, but the farmers, having beaten him, sent him away empty.

11 And he proceeded to send another slave, but they, having beaten and dishonored that one also, sent him away empty.

12 And he proceeded to send a third, but they, having wounded this one also, cast him out.

13 And the master of the vineyard said, What shall I do? I will send my beloved son; perhaps, having seen him, they will respect him.

14 But having seen him, the farmers were reasoning among themselves, saying, This is the heir. Come, let us kill him, so that the inheritance may become ours.

15 And having cast him outside the vineyard, they killed him. What therefore will the master of the vineyard do to them?

16 He will come and destroy these farmers and give the vineyard to others. And having heard, they said, May it not happen.

17 But having looked at them, he said, What therefore is this that is written: The stone which the builders rejected, this became the head of the corner?

18 Everyone who falls upon that stone will be shattered, but upon whomever it falls, it will crush him.

19 And the chief priests and the scribes sought to lay hands on him in that very hour, and feared the people, for they knew that he told this parable against them.

20 And having watched closely, they sent spies pretending themselves to be righteous, so that they might seize upon his word, to hand him over to the rule and the authority of the governor.

21 And they asked him, saying, Teacher, we know that you speak and teach rightly, and do not show partiality, but teach the way of God in truth.

22 Is it lawful for us to give tribute to Caesar or not?

23 But having perceived their craftiness, he said to them, Why do you test me?

24 Show me a denarius. Whose image and inscription does it have? And answering, they said, Caesar's.

25 And he said to them, Therefore give back the things of Caesar to Caesar, and the things of God to God.

26 And they were not able to seize upon his saying before the people, and having marveled at his answer, they were silent.

27 And some of the Sadducees, those disputing that there is a resurrection, having approached, asked him,

28 saying, Teacher, Moses wrote to us, If anyone's brother dies having a wife, and he dies childless, that his brother should take the wife and raise up seed for his brother.

29 There were therefore seven brothers, and the first, having taken a wife, died childless.

30 And the second took the wife, and he died childless.

31 And the third took her, and likewise also the seven did not leave children and died.

32 And later than all, the woman also died.

33 In the resurrection, therefore, of which of them does she become the wife? For the seven had her as wife.

34 And answering, Jesus said to them, The sons of this age marry and are given in marriage.

35 But those counted worthy to attain that age and the resurrection from the dead neither marry nor are given in marriage.

36 For neither can they die any longer, for they are equal to angels and are sons of God, being sons of the resurrection.

37 But that the dead are raised, even Moses disclosed at the bush, when he calls the Lord the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob.

38 And he is not God of the dead, but of the living, for all live to him.

39 And answering, some of the scribes said, Teacher, you spoke well.

40 And they no longer dared to ask him anything.

41 And he said to them, How do they say that the Christ is David's son?

42 And David himself says in the book of Psalms, The Lord said to my Lord, Sit at my right,

43 until I place your enemies as a footstool for your feet.

44 David therefore calls him Lord, and how is he his son?

45 And while all the people were hearing, he said to his disciples,

46 Beware of the scribes who wish to walk in robes, and love greetings in the marketplaces, and first seats in the synagogues, and first places at dinners,

47 who devour the houses of widows and as a pretext pray at length. These will receive greater judgment.

Chapter 21

1 And having looked up, he saw the rich putting their gifts into the treasury.

2 And he also saw a certain needy widow putting two lepta there.

3 And he said, Truly I say to you that this poor widow put in more than all.

4 For all these put into the gifts of God from what abounded to them, but she, from her lack, put in all the livelihood she had.

5 And as some were speaking about the temple, that it was adorned with beautiful stones and dedicated offerings, he said,

6 These things which you behold, days will come in which a stone will not be left upon a stone that will not be torn down.

7 And they asked him, saying, Teacher, when therefore will these things be, and what is the sign when these things are about to happen?

8 And he said, See that you are not led astray, for many will come in my name, saying, I am, and, The time has drawn near. Do not therefore go after them.

9 And when you hear of wars and disorders, do not be terrified, for these things must happen first, but the end is not immediately.

10 Then he was saying to them, Nation will rise against nation, and kingdom against kingdom.

11 And there will be great earthquakes in various places, and famines and plagues, and there will be terrors and great signs from heaven.

12 But before all these things they will lay their hands on you and persecute you, handing you over to synagogues and prisons, being led before kings and governors for the sake of my name.

13 And it will turn out for you as a testimony.

14 Settle therefore in your hearts not to rehearse beforehand how to defend yourselves.

15 For I will give you a mouth and wisdom which all those opposing you will not be able to contradict or resist.

16 And you will be handed over even by parents and brothers and relatives and friends, and they will put some of you to death.

17 And you will be hated by all because of my name.

18 And a hair from your head will certainly not perish.

19 In your endurance acquire your lives.

20 And when you see Jerusalem being encircled by armies, then know that her desolation has drawn near.

21 Then let those in Judea flee into the mountains, and let those in her midst depart, and let those in the countryside not enter into her.

22 Because these are days of vengeance, for all the things written to be fulfilled.

23 But woe to those having a child in the womb and to those nursing in those days, for there will be great distress upon the land and wrath among this people.

24 And they will fall by the mouth of the sword, and will be taken captive into all the nations, and Jerusalem will be trampled by nations until the times of nations are fulfilled.

25 And there will be signs in sun and moon and stars, and upon the earth distress of nations in perplexity, the sea and the surge resounding,

26 people fainting from fear and expectation of the things coming upon the inhabited world, for the powers of the heavens will be shaken.

27 And then they will see the Son of Man coming in a cloud with power and much glory.

28 And when these things begin to happen, straighten up and lift up your heads, because your redemption draws near.

29 And he told them a parable: See the fig tree and all the trees.

30 When they already put forth growth, seeing it, you know from yourselves that summer is already near.

31 Thus also you, when you see these things happening, know that the kingdom of God is near.

32 Amen, I say to you that this generation will certainly not pass away until all things happen.

33 Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will certainly not pass away.

34 But pay attention to yourselves, lest your hearts be weighed down in dissipation and drunkenness and cares of life, and that day come upon you suddenly.

35 For as a snare it will come upon all those sitting upon the face of all the earth.

36 Stay awake therefore at every time, pleading that you may be counted worthy to escape all these things about to happen and to stand before the Son of Man.

37 And during the days he was teaching in the temple, but during the nights, going out, he was lodging on the mountain called Olives.

38 And all the people were coming early in the morning to him in the temple to hear him.

Chapter 22

1 And the feast of Unleavened Bread, called Passover, was drawing near.

2 And the chief priests and the scribes were seeking how they might kill him, for they feared the people.

3 And Satan entered into Judas, surnamed Iscariot, being of the number of the twelve.

4 And having gone away, he spoke together with the chief priests and the captains about how he might hand him over to them.

5 And they rejoiced, and agreed to give him silver.

6 And he consented, and was seeking an opportunity to hand him over to them apart from a crowd.

7 And the day of Unleavened Bread came, on which the Passover had to be sacrificed.

8 And he sent Peter and John, saying, Go and prepare the Passover for us, so that we may eat.

9 And they said to him, Where do you wish us to prepare?

10 And he said to them, Look, when you have entered into the city, a man carrying a jar of water will meet you. Follow him into the house where he enters.

11 And you shall say to the master of the house, The Teacher says to you, Where is the lodging room where I may eat the Passover with my disciples?

12 And he will show you a large upper room furnished; prepare there.

13 And having gone away, they found it just as he had said to them, and prepared the Passover.

14 And when the hour came, he reclined, and the twelve apostles with him.

15 And he said to them, With desire I desired to eat this Passover with you before I suffer.

16 For I say to you that I will certainly no longer eat of it until it is fulfilled in the kingdom of God.

17 And having received a cup, having given thanks, he said, Take this and divide it among yourselves.

18 For I say to you that I will certainly not drink from the produce of the vine until the kingdom of God comes.

19 And having taken bread, having given thanks, he broke it and gave it to them, saying, This is my body, which is given for you. Do this for my remembrance.

20 Likewise also the cup after dining, saying, This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.

21 Nevertheless, look, the hand of the one handing me over is with me upon the table.

22 And the Son of Man indeed goes according to what has been determined; nevertheless, woe to that man through whom he is handed over.

23 And they began to discuss among themselves who then it might be of them who was about to do this.

24 And a contention also arose among them as to which of them is considered to be greater.

25 And he said to them, The kings of the nations lord it over them, and those exercising authority over them are called benefactors.

26 But you shall not be thus; rather, let the greater among you become as the younger, and the one leading as the one serving.

27 For who is greater, the one reclining or the one serving? Is it not the one reclining? But I am in your midst as the one serving.

28 And you are those who have remained with me in my trials.

29 And I appoint to you a kingdom, just as my Father appointed to me,

30 so that you may eat and drink at my table in my kingdom, and sit on thrones judging the twelve tribes of Israel.

31 And the Lord said, Simon, Simon, look, Satan demanded you all, to sift you as wheat.

32 But I pleaded concerning you, so that your faith may not fail; and you, when you have turned back, strengthen your brothers.

33 And he said to him, Lord, with you I am ready to go both into prison and into death.

34 And he said, I say to you, Peter, a rooster will certainly not call today before you deny three times that you know me.

35 And he said to them, When I sent you without purse and bag and sandals, did you lack anything? And they said, Nothing.

36 He said therefore to them, But now let the one having a purse take it, likewise also a bag; and let the one not having sell his garment and buy a sword.

37 For I say to you that this thing written must still be completed in me: And he was reckoned with lawless ones. For also the things concerning me have an end.

38 And they said, Lord, look, here are two swords. And he said to them, It is enough.

39 And having gone out, he went according to his custom to the Mount of Olives, and his disciples also followed him.

40 And having come to the place, he said to them, Pray not to enter into temptation.

41 And he withdrew from them about a stone's throw, and having placed his knees down, was praying,

42 saying, Father, if you will, to take this cup away from me; nevertheless, let not my will, but yours, happen.

43 And an angel from heaven appeared to him, strengthening him.

44 And having come into agony, he was praying more earnestly; and his sweat became as clots of blood coming down upon the ground.

45 And having risen from prayer, having come to the disciples, he found them sleeping from sorrow.

46 And he said to them, Why do you sleep? Rise and pray, so that you may not enter into temptation.

47 And while he was still speaking, look, a crowd, and the one called Judas, one of the twelve, was going before them, and drew near to Jesus to kiss him.

48 But Jesus said to him, Judas, do you hand over the Son of Man with a kiss?

49 And those around him, having seen what would happen, said to him, Lord, shall we strike with a sword?

50 And a certain one of them struck the slave of the high priest, and took off his right ear.

51 But answering, Jesus said, Allow it as far as this. And having touched his ear, he healed him.

52 And Jesus said to the chief priests and captains of the temple and elders who had come against him, Did you come out as against a robber, with swords and clubs?

53 When I was with you daily in the temple, you did not stretch out your hands against me. But this is your hour, and the authority of darkness.

54 And having seized him, they led him and brought him into the house of the high priest. But Peter was following far away.

55 And when they had kindled a fire in the midst of the courtyard and had sat down together, Peter was sitting in their midst.

56 And a certain servant girl, having seen him sitting toward the light and having looked intently at him, said, This man also was with him.

57 But he denied him, saying, Woman, I do not know him.

58 And after a little while, another, having seen him, said, You too are of them. But Peter said, Man, I am not.

59 And about one hour having elapsed, a certain other was insisting, saying, In truth, this man too was with him, for he is also a Galilean.

60 But Peter said, Man, I do not know what you say. And immediately, while he was still speaking, the rooster called.

61 And having turned, the Lord looked at Peter, and Peter was reminded of the word of the Lord, how he said to him, Before a rooster calls, you will deny me three times.

62 And having gone outside, Peter wept bitterly.

63 And the men holding Jesus were mocking him, beating him.

64 And having covered him, they were striking his face, and asking him, saying, Prophesy: Who is the one who struck you?

65 And blaspheming, they were saying many other things against him.

66 And when day came, the eldership of the people was gathered, both chief priests and scribes, and they brought him up into their council, saying,

67 If you are the Christ, tell us. But he said to them, If I tell you, you will certainly not believe.

68 And if I also ask, you will certainly not answer me or release me.

69 From now the Son of Man will be sitting at the right of the power of God.

70 And all said, Are you therefore the Son of God? And he said to them, You say that I am.

71 And they said, What further need do we have of testimony? For we ourselves heard from his mouth.

Chapter 23

1 And the whole multitude of them, having risen, led him before Pilate.

2 And they began to accuse him, saying, We found this man perverting the nation and forbidding tribute to be given to Caesar, saying that he himself is Christ, a king.

3 And Pilate asked him, saying, Are you the King of the Jews? And answering him, he said, You say it.

4 And Pilate said to the chief priests and the crowds, I find no fault in this man.

5 But they were insisting, saying that he stirs up the people, teaching throughout all Judea, having begun from Galilee as far as here.

6 And Pilate, having heard Galilee, asked if the man is a Galilean.

7 And having learned that he is of Herod's authority, he sent him up to Herod, who himself was also in Jerusalem in these days.

8 And Herod, having seen Jesus, rejoiced greatly, for he had been wishing for a considerable time to see him, because of hearing many things about him; and he was hoping to see some sign done by him.

9 And he was questioning him with many words, but he answered him nothing.

10 And the chief priests and the scribes stood, vehemently accusing him.

11 And Herod, having despised him with his troops and having mocked him, having clothed him in a splendid garment, sent him up to Pilate.

12 And both Pilate and Herod became friends with each other on that very day, for previously they had been in enmity toward each other.

13 And Pilate, having called together the chief priests and the rulers and the people,

14 said to them, You brought this man to me as one turning the people away, and look, I, having examined him before you, found in this man no fault of the things you accuse him of.

15 But neither did Herod, for I sent you up to him, and look, nothing worthy of death has been done by him.

16 Having therefore chastised him, I will release him.

17 And he had a necessity to release one to them at the feast.

18 And they cried out with the whole multitude, saying, Take this man away, but release Barabbas to us,

19 who had been thrown into prison because of a certain uprising that happened in the city and murder.

20 Again therefore Pilate addressed them, wishing to release Jesus.

21 But they were shouting, saying, Crucify, crucify him.

22 And a third time he said to them, For what evil did this man do? I found no fault deserving death in him. Having therefore chastised him, I will release him.

23 But they were pressing with loud voices, demanding that he be crucified, and their voices and those of the chief priests were prevailing.

24 And Pilate decided that their demand should happen.

25 And he released to them the one who had been thrown into the prison because of uprising and murder, whom they were demanding, but Jesus he handed over to their will.

26 And as they led him away, having seized a certain Simon of Cyrene, coming from the countryside, they laid the cross upon him to carry behind Jesus.

27 And a great multitude of the people was following him, and of women, who were also beating themselves and lamenting him.

28 But Jesus, having turned to them, said, Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep over me, but weep over yourselves and over your children.

29 Because look, days are coming in which they will say, Blessed are the barren, and wombs that did not bear, and breasts that did not nurse.

30 Then they will begin to say to the mountains, Fall upon us, and to the hills, Cover us.

31 Because if they do these things in the moist wood, what may happen in the dry?

32 And two others also, criminals, were being led with him to be killed.

33 And when they came to the place called Skull, there they crucified him and the criminals, one on the right and one on the left.

34 But Jesus was saying, Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they do. And dividing his garments, they cast a lot.

35 And the people stood beholding, and the rulers also were sneering with them, saying, He saved others; let him save himself, if this is the Christ, the chosen one of God.

36 And the soldiers also were mocking him, approaching and offering him vinegar,

37 and saying, If you are the King of the Jews, save yourself.

38 And there was also an inscription written over him in Greek and Roman and Hebrew letters: This is the King of the Jews.

39 And one of the criminals who had been hung was blaspheming him, saying, If you are the Christ, save yourself and us.

40 But answering, the other was rebuking him, saying, Do you not even fear God, because you are in the same judgment?

41 And we indeed justly, for we receive things worthy of what we did, but this man did nothing improper.

42 And he was saying to Jesus, Remember me, Lord, when you come in your kingdom.

43 And Jesus said to him, Amen, I say to you, Today you will be with me in Paradise.

44 And it was about the sixth hour, and darkness came upon all the earth until the ninth hour.

45 And the sun was darkened, and the veil of the sanctuary was torn in the middle.

46 And having called with a loud voice, Jesus said, Father, into your hands I will entrust my spirit. And having said these things, he breathed out.

47 And the centurion, having seen what happened, glorified God, saying, Indeed this man was righteous.

48 And all the crowds who had come together to this spectacle, beholding the things that happened, were returning, striking their own chests.

49 And all his acquaintances stood far away, and women who had followed him from Galilee, seeing these things.

50 And look, a man named Joseph, being a council member, a good and righteous man,

51 this man had not consented to their counsel and action, from Arimathea, a city of the Jews, who himself also was awaiting the kingdom of God.

52 This man, having approached Pilate, asked for the body of Jesus.

53 And having taken it down, he wrapped it in linen and placed it in a rock-hewn tomb, where no one had yet been laid.

54 And it was the day of Preparation, and the Sabbath was dawning.

55 And women also who had come with him from Galilee, having followed after, beheld the tomb and how his body was placed.

56 And having returned, they prepared spices and ointments, and on the Sabbath indeed they rested according to the commandment.

Chapter 24

1 And on the first day of the week, at deep dawn, they came to the tomb, bringing the spices they prepared, and some others with them.

2 And they found the stone rolled away from the tomb.

3 And having entered, they did not find the body of the Lord Jesus.

4 And it happened as they were greatly perplexed about this that look, two men stood by them in flashing garments.

5 And as they became fearful and bowed their face to the ground, they said to them, Why do you seek the living one among the dead?

6 He is not here, but was raised. Remember how he spoke to you while still being in Galilee,

7 saying that the Son of Man must be handed over into the hands of sinful people and be crucified, and on the third day rise.

8 And they remembered his sayings.

9 And having returned from the tomb, they reported all these things to the eleven and to all the rest.

10 And they were Mary Magdalene and Joanna and Mary of James and the rest with them, who were telling these things to the apostles.

11 And their sayings appeared before them as nonsense, and they were disbelieving them.

12 But Peter, having risen, ran to the tomb, and having stooped to look, sees the linen cloths lying alone; and he went away to himself, marveling at what had happened.

13 And look, two of them were going on that very day to a village sixty stadia distant from Jerusalem, whose name was Emmaus.

14 And they were conversing with each other about all these things that had happened.

15 And it happened as they were conversing and discussing that Jesus himself, having drawn near, was going with them.

16 But their eyes were held from recognizing him.

17 And he said to them, What are these words which you exchange with each other while walking, and you are gloomy?

18 And answering, the one whose name was Cleopas said to him, Do you alone sojourn in Jerusalem and not know the things that happened in it in these days?

19 And he said to them, What things? And they said to him, The things concerning Jesus the Nazarene, who became a man, a prophet mighty in deed and word before God and all the people,

20 and how the chief priests and our rulers handed him over to a judgment of death and crucified him.

21 But we were hoping that he is the one about to redeem Israel. But indeed, with all these things, today brings this third day since these things happened.

22 But also some women from among us astonished us, having been at the tomb early,

23 and not having found his body, they came, saying also that they had seen a vision of angels who say that he lives.

24 And some of those with us went away to the tomb and found it thus, just as the women also said, but they did not see him.

25 And he said to them, O foolish and slow in heart to believe all that the prophets spoke!

26 Did not the Christ have to suffer these things and enter into his glory?

27 And having begun from Moses and from all the prophets, he was interpreting to them in all the Scriptures the things concerning himself.

28 And they drew near to the village where they were going, and he was acting as though going farther.

29 And they urged him strongly, saying, Stay with us, because it is toward evening and the day has declined. And he entered to stay with them.

30 And it happened when he reclined with them that having taken the bread, he blessed, and having broken it, was giving it to them.

31 And their eyes were opened, and they recognized him, and he became invisible from them.

32 And they said to each other, Was not our heart burning within us as he was speaking to us on the road, and as he was opening the Scriptures to us?

33 And having risen in that very hour, they returned to Jerusalem and found the eleven and those with them gathered,

34 saying that the Lord was truly raised and appeared to Simon.

35 And they were relating the things on the road, and how he was known to them in the breaking of the bread.

36 And as they were speaking these things, Jesus himself stood in their midst and says to them, Peace to you.

37 But having been terrified and having become fearful, they supposed they were beholding a spirit.

38 And he said to them, Why are you troubled, and why do reasonings rise in your hearts?

39 See my hands and my feet, that I myself am he. Feel me and see, because a spirit does not have flesh and bones as you behold me having.

40 And having said this, he showed them his hands and feet.

41 And while they were still disbelieving from joy and marveling, he said to them, Do you have anything edible here?

42 And they gave him a portion of broiled fish and some from a honeycomb.

43 And having taken it, he ate before them.

44 And he said to them, These are the words which I spoke to you while still being with you, that all the things written in the law of Moses and prophets and Psalms concerning me must be fulfilled.

45 Then he opened their mind to understand the Scriptures.

46 And he said to them that thus it is written, and thus the Christ had to suffer and rise from the dead on the third day,

47 and repentance and forgiveness of sins to be proclaimed in his name to all the nations, beginning from Jerusalem.

48 And you are witnesses of these things.

49 And look, I send the promise of my Father upon you. But you, remain in the city of Jerusalem until you are clothed with power from on high.

50 And he led them out as far as Bethany, and having lifted his hands, blessed them.

51 And it happened as he was blessing them that he parted from them and was carried up into heaven.

52 And they, having worshiped him, returned to Jerusalem with great joy.

53 And they were continually in the temple, praising and blessing God. Amen.

John

Chapter 1

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God.

2 He was in the beginning with God.

3 All things came into being through him, and apart from him not even one thing came into being that has come into being.

4 In him was life, and the life was the light of people.

5 And the light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not grasp it.

6 There came a man sent from God; his name was John.

7 He came for testimony, so that he might testify concerning the light, so that all might believe through him.

8 He was not the light, but came so that he might testify concerning the light.

9 He was the true light, which illuminates every person coming into the world.

10 He was in the world, and the world came into being through him, and the world did not know him.

11 He came to his own things, and his own people did not receive him.

12 But as many as received him, he gave them authority to become children of God, to those believing in his name,

13 who were born not from bloods, nor from the will of flesh, nor from the will of a man, but from God.

14 And the Word became flesh and dwelt in a tent among us, and we beheld his glory, glory as of an only-begotten one from the Father, full of grace and truth.

15 John testifies concerning him and has cried out, saying, This was the one of whom I said, The one coming after me has come to be before me, because he was before me.

16 And from his fullness we all received, and grace in place of grace.

17 Because the law was given through Moses; grace and truth came through Jesus Christ.

18 No one has ever seen God; the only-begotten Son, who is in the bosom of the Father, he explained him.

19 And this is the testimony of John, when the Jews sent priests and Levites from Jerusalem so that they might ask him, Who are you?

20 And he confessed and did not deny, and confessed that I am not the Christ.

21 And they asked him, What then? Are you Elijah? And he says, I am not. Are you the Prophet? And he answered, No.

22 They said therefore to him, Who are you, so that we may give an answer to those who sent us? What do you say concerning yourself?

23 He said, I am a voice of one crying in the wilderness, Make straight the way of the Lord, just as Isaiah the prophet said.

24 And those sent were from the Pharisees.

25 And they asked him and said to him, Why then do you baptize, if you are not the Christ, nor Elijah, nor the Prophet?

26 John answered them, saying, I baptize in water, but in your midst stands one whom you do not know.

27 He is the one coming after me, who has come to be before me, whose sandal strap I am not worthy to untie.

28 These things happened in Bethabara beyond the Jordan, where John was baptizing.

29 On the next day John sees Jesus coming to him and says, See, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world.

30 This is he concerning whom I said, After me comes a man who has come to be before me, because he was before me.

31 And I did not know him, but so that he might be manifested to Israel, for this I came baptizing in water.

32 And John testified, saying, I have beheld the Spirit descending as a dove from heaven, and it remained upon him.

33 And I did not know him, but the one who sent me to baptize in water, he said to me, Upon whomever you see the Spirit descending and remaining upon him, this is the one baptizing in the Holy Spirit.

34 And I have seen and have testified that this is the Son of God.

35 On the next day John again stood, and two of his disciples.

36 And having looked at Jesus walking, he says, See, the Lamb of God.

37 And the two disciples heard him speaking and followed Jesus.

38 But Jesus, having turned and having beheld them following, says to them, What do you seek? And they said to him, Rabbi, which translated is said, Teacher, where do you stay?

39 He says to them, Come and see. They came and saw where he stays, and stayed with him that day; and it was about the tenth hour.

40 Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, was one of the two who heard from John and followed him.

41 This man first finds his own brother Simon and says to him, We have found the Messiah, which translated is the Christ.

42 And he brought him to Jesus. And Jesus, having looked at him, said, You are Simon, the son of Jonah; you will be called Cephas, which is translated Peter.

43 On the next day Jesus wished to go out into Galilee, and finds Philip and says to him, Follow me.

44 And Philip was from Bethsaida, from the city of Andrew and Peter.

45 Philip finds Nathanael and says to him, We have found the one of whom Moses wrote in the law, and the prophets: Jesus, the son of Joseph, from Nazareth.

46 And Nathanael said to him, Can anything good be from Nazareth? Philip says to him, Come and see.

47 Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him and says concerning him, See, truly an Israelite in whom there is no deceit.

48 Nathanael says to him, From where do you know me? Jesus answered and said to him, Before Philip called you, being under the fig tree, I saw you.

49 Nathanael answered and says to him, Rabbi, you are the Son of God; you are the King of Israel.

50 Jesus answered and said to him, Because I said to you, I saw you beneath the fig tree, do you believe? You will see greater things than these.

51 And he says to him, Amen, amen, I say to you, From now you will see heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending upon the Son of Man.

Chapter 2

1 And on the third day a wedding took place in Cana of Galilee, and the mother of Jesus was there.

2 And Jesus also was invited, and his disciples, to the wedding.

3 And when wine was lacking, the mother of Jesus says to him, They have no wine.

4 Jesus says to her, What is there to me and to you, woman? My hour has not yet come.

5 His mother says to the servants, Whatever he says to you, do.

6 And six stone water jars were lying there, according to the purification of the Jews, holding two or three measures each.

7 Jesus says to them, Fill the water jars with water. And they filled them to the top.

8 And he says to them, Draw now and carry to the master of the feast. And they carried it.

9 And when the master of the feast tasted the water that had become wine, and did not know from where it is, but the servants who had drawn the water knew, the master of the feast calls the bridegroom,

10 and says to him, Every person sets out the good wine first, and when they have become drunk, then the inferior. You have kept the good wine until now.

11 Jesus did this beginning of the signs in Cana of Galilee, and manifested his glory, and his disciples believed in him.

12 After this he went down to Capernaum, he and his mother and his brothers and his disciples, and they stayed there not many days.

13 And the Passover of the Jews was near, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

14 And he found in the temple those selling oxen and sheep and doves, and the money changers sitting.

15 And having made a whip from cords, he cast all out of the temple, both the sheep and the oxen, and poured out the coins of the money changers and overturned the tables.

16 And he said to those selling the doves, Take these things away from here; do not make my Father's house a house of trade.

17 And his disciples remembered that it is written, The zeal of your house devoured me.

18 The Jews therefore answered and said to him, What sign do you show us, because you do these things?

19 Jesus answered and said to them, Destroy this sanctuary, and in three days I will raise it.

20 The Jews therefore said, In forty-six years this sanctuary was built, and will you raise it in three days?

21 But he was speaking concerning the sanctuary of his body.

22 When therefore he was raised from the dead, his disciples remembered that he was saying this to them, and believed the Scripture and the word which Jesus said.

23 And when he was in Jerusalem at the Passover, at the feast, many believed in his name, beholding his signs which he was doing.

24 But Jesus himself was not entrusting himself to them, because he knew all,

25 and because he had no need that anyone testify concerning the person, for he himself knew what was in the person.

Chapter 3

1 And there was a man from the Pharisees, Nicodemus his name, a ruler of the Jews.

2 This man came to Jesus by night and said to him, Rabbi, we know that you have come from God as a teacher, for no one can do these signs which you do unless God is with him.

3 Jesus answered and said to him, Amen, amen, I say to you, Unless someone is born from above, he cannot see the kingdom of God.

4 Nicodemus says to him, How can a person be born, being old? He cannot enter a second time into his mother's womb and be born, can he?

5 Jesus answered, Amen, amen, I say to you, Unless someone is born from water and Spirit, he cannot enter into the kingdom of God.

6 What has been born from the flesh is flesh, and what has been born from the Spirit is spirit.

7 Do not marvel that I said to you, You must be born from above.

8 The spirit blows where it wishes, and you hear its voice, but do not know from where it comes and where it goes. Thus is everyone who has been born from the Spirit.

9 Nicodemus answered and said to him, How can these things happen?

10 Jesus answered and said to him, Are you the teacher of Israel, and do not know these things?

11 Amen, amen, I say to you that what we know we speak, and what we have seen we testify, and you do not receive our testimony.

12 If I told you the earthly things and you do not believe, how will you believe if I tell you the heavenly things?

13 And no one has ascended into heaven except the one who descended from heaven, the Son of Man, who is in heaven.

14 And just as Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness, thus the Son of Man must be lifted up,

15 so that everyone believing in him may not perish, but have eternal life.

16 For thus God loved the world, so that he gave his only-begotten Son, so that everyone believing in him may not perish, but have eternal life.

17 For God did not send his Son into the world so that he might judge the world, but so that the world might be saved through him.

18 The one believing in him is not judged, but the one not believing has already been judged, because he has not believed in the name of the only-begotten Son of God.

19 And this is the judgment, that the light has come into the world, and people loved the darkness rather than the light, for their works were wicked.

20 For everyone practicing base things hates the light and does not come to the light, so that his works may not be exposed.

21 But the one doing the truth comes to the light, so that his works may be manifested, that they have been worked in God.

22 After these things Jesus and his disciples came into the land of Judea, and there he was spending time with them and baptizing.

23 And John also was baptizing in Aenon near Salim, because there were many waters there, and they were coming and being baptized.

24 For John had not yet been thrown into the prison.

25 There arose therefore a dispute from John's disciples with Jews concerning purification.

26 And they came to John and said to him, Rabbi, the one who was with you beyond the Jordan, to whom you have testified, see, this man baptizes, and all come to him.

27 John answered and said, A person can receive nothing unless it has been given to him from heaven.

28 You yourselves testify to me that I said, I am not the Christ, but that I have been sent before him.

29 The one having the bride is the bridegroom, but the friend of the bridegroom, who stands and hears him, rejoices with joy because of the bridegroom's voice. This joy of mine therefore has been fulfilled.

30 He must increase, but I must decrease.

31 The one coming from above is above all. The one being from the earth is from the earth and speaks from the earth. The one coming from heaven is above all.

32 And what he has seen and heard, this he testifies, and no one receives his testimony.

33 The one who received his testimony sealed that God is true.

34 For the one whom God sent speaks the sayings of God, for God does not give the Spirit by measure.

35 The Father loves the Son and has given all things in his hand.

36 The one believing in the Son has eternal life, but the one disobeying the Son will not see life, but the wrath of God remains upon him.

Chapter 4

1 When therefore the Lord knew that the Pharisees heard that Jesus makes and baptizes more disciples than John,

2 although Jesus himself was not baptizing, but his disciples,

3 he left Judea and went away again into Galilee.

4 And he had to pass through Samaria.

5 He comes therefore into a city of Samaria called Sychar, near the field which Jacob gave to Joseph his son.

6 And Jacob's spring was there. Jesus therefore, having become wearied from the journey, was sitting thus at the spring. It was about the sixth hour.

7 A woman from Samaria comes to draw water. Jesus says to her, Give me to drink.

8 For his disciples had gone away into the city so that they might buy food.

9 The Samaritan woman therefore says to him, How do you, being a Jew, ask to drink from me, being a Samaritan woman? For Jews do not associate with Samaritans.

10 Jesus answered and said to her, If you knew the gift of God, and who is the one saying to you, Give me to drink, you would have asked him, and he would have given you living water.

11 The woman says to him, Sir, you do not even have a drawing vessel, and the well is deep. From where therefore do you have the living water?

12 You are not greater than our father Jacob, who gave us the well and drank from it himself, and his sons and his livestock, are you?

13 Jesus answered and said to her, Everyone drinking from this water will thirst again.

14 But whoever drinks from the water which I will give him will certainly not thirst forever, but the water which I will give him will become in him a spring of water leaping into eternal life.

15 The woman says to him, Sir, give me this water, so that I may not thirst nor come here to draw.

16 Jesus says to her, Go, call your husband, and come here.

17 The woman answered and said, I have no husband. Jesus says to her, You said well, I have no husband.

18 For you had five husbands, and the one you now have is not your husband. This you have spoken truly.

19 The woman says to him, Sir, I behold that you are a prophet.

20 Our fathers worshiped on this mountain, and you say that in Jerusalem is the place where one must worship.

21 Jesus says to her, Woman, believe me that an hour comes when neither on this mountain nor in Jerusalem will you worship the Father.

22 You worship what you do not know; we worship what we know, because salvation is from the Jews.

23 But an hour comes, and now is, when the true worshipers will worship the Father in spirit and truth, for the Father also seeks such as those worshiping him.

24 God is spirit, and those worshiping him must worship in spirit and truth.

25 The woman says to him, I know that Messiah comes, the one called Christ. When he comes, he will announce all things to us.

26 Jesus says to her, I am, the one speaking to you.

27 And upon this his disciples came, and marveled that he was speaking with a woman. Nevertheless no one said, What do you seek? or, Why do you speak with her?

28 The woman therefore left her water jar and went away into the city, and says to the people,

29 Come, see a man who told me all things that I did. Could this be the Christ?

30 They therefore went out from the city and were coming to him.

31 And in the meantime the disciples were asking him, saying, Rabbi, eat.

32 But he said to them, I have food to eat which you do not know.

33 The disciples therefore were saying to each other, Did anyone bring him something to eat?

34 Jesus says to them, My food is that I may do the will of the one who sent me and complete his work.

35 Do you not say that there are still four months, and the harvest comes? Look, I say to you, Lift up your eyes and behold the fields, because they are already white for harvest.

36 And the one reaping receives wages and gathers fruit into eternal life, so that both the one sowing and the one reaping may rejoice together.

37 For in this the saying is true, that one is the one sowing and another the one reaping.

38 I sent you to reap what you have not labored for. Others have labored, and you have entered into their labor.

39 And from that city many of the Samaritans believed in him because of the word of the woman testifying that he told me all things that I did.

40 When therefore the Samaritans came to him, they were asking him to stay with them, and he stayed there two days.

41 And many more believed because of his word.

42 And they were saying to the woman, We no longer believe because of your speech, for we ourselves have heard and know that this is truly the Savior of the world, the Christ.

43 And after the two days he went out from there and went away into Galilee.

44 For Jesus himself testified that a prophet has no honor in his own homeland.

45 When therefore he came into Galilee, the Galileans received him, having seen all the things he did in Jerusalem at the feast, for they also came to the feast.

46 Jesus therefore came again into Cana of Galilee, where he made the water wine. And there was a certain royal official whose son was sick in Capernaum.

47 This man, having heard that Jesus has come from Judea into Galilee, went away to him and was asking him to come down and heal his son, for he was about to die.

48 Jesus therefore said to him, Unless you see signs and wonders, you will certainly not believe.

49 The royal official says to him, Sir, come down before my child dies.

50 Jesus says to him, Go; your son lives. And the man believed the word which Jesus said to him, and was going.

51 And as he was already going down, his slaves met him and reported, saying that your boy lives.

52 He therefore inquired from them the hour in which he became better, and they said to him, Yesterday at the seventh hour the fever left him.

53 The father therefore knew that it was in that hour in which Jesus said to him, Your son lives, and he himself believed, and his whole house.

54 This again Jesus did as a second sign, having come from Judea into Galilee.

Chapter 5

1 After these things there was a feast of the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.

2 And in Jerusalem at the Sheep Gate there is a pool, called in Hebrew Bethesda, having five porticoes.

3 In these lay a great multitude of the sick, blind, lame, withered, awaiting the movement of the water.

4 For an angel at a season was descending in the pool and troubling the water. Therefore the first who stepped in after the troubling of the water became healthy, with whatever disease he was held.

5 And a certain man was there, having thirty-eight years in sickness.

6 Jesus, having seen him lying and having known that he already has much time, says to him, Do you wish to become healthy?

7 The sick man answered him, Sir, I have no person to put me into the pool when the water is troubled; but while I am coming, another goes down before me.

8 Jesus says to him, Rise, take up your pallet, and walk.

9 And immediately the man became healthy, and took up his pallet and was walking. And it was Sabbath on that day.

10 The Jews therefore were saying to the one healed, It is Sabbath; it is not lawful for you to take up the pallet.

11 He answered them, The one who made me healthy, he said to me, Take up your pallet and walk.

12 They therefore asked him, Who is the man who said to you, Take up your pallet and walk?

13 But the one healed did not know who he is, for Jesus slipped away, a crowd being in the place.

14 After these things Jesus finds him in the temple and said to him, See, you have become healthy. Sin no longer, so that something worse may not happen to you.

15 The man went away and announced to the Jews that Jesus is the one who made him healthy.

16 And because of this the Jews were persecuting Jesus and seeking to kill him, because he was doing these things on Sabbath.

17 But Jesus answered them, My Father works until now, and I work.

18 Because of this therefore the Jews were seeking still more to kill him, because he was not only breaking the Sabbath, but also calling God his own Father, making himself equal to God.

19 Jesus therefore answered and said to them, Amen, amen, I say to you, The Son can do nothing from himself unless he sees the Father doing something, for whatever he does, these things the Son also does likewise.

20 For the Father loves the Son and shows him all things which he himself does, and will show him greater works than these, so that you may marvel.

21 For just as the Father raises the dead and makes them alive, thus also the Son makes alive those whom he wishes.

22 For neither does the Father judge anyone, but has given all judgment to the Son,

23 so that all may honor the Son just as they honor the Father. The one not honoring the Son does not honor the Father who sent him.

24 Amen, amen, I say to you that the one hearing my word and believing the one who sent me has eternal life, and does not come into judgment, but has passed from death into life.

25 Amen, amen, I say to you that an hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the voice of the Son of God, and those who heard will live.

26 For just as the Father has life in himself, thus he also gave to the Son to have life in himself.

27 And he also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is Son of Man.

28 Do not marvel at this, because an hour comes in which all those in the tombs will hear his voice,

29 and will go out, those who did the good things into a resurrection of life, but those who practiced the base things into a resurrection of judgment.

30 I can do nothing from myself. Just as I hear, I judge, and my judgment is righteous, because I do not seek my own will, but the will of the Father who sent me.

31 If I testify concerning myself, my testimony is not true.

32 There is another who testifies concerning me, and I know that the testimony which he testifies concerning me is true.

33 You have sent to John, and he has testified to the truth.

34 But I do not receive testimony from a person; rather, I say these things so that you may be saved.

35 He was the lamp burning and shining, but you wished to exult for an hour in his light.

36 But I have testimony greater than John's, for the works which the Father gave me so that I may complete them, the very works which I do, testify concerning me that the Father has sent me.

37 And the Father who sent me has himself testified concerning me. You have neither ever heard his voice nor seen his form.

38 And you do not have his word remaining in you, because the one whom he sent, this one you do not believe.

39 Search the Scriptures, because you suppose you have eternal life in them, and they are those testifying concerning me.

40 And you do not wish to come to me so that you may have life.

41 I do not receive glory from people.

42 But I have known you, that you do not have the love of God in yourselves.

43 I have come in the name of my Father, and you do not receive me. If another comes in his own name, you will receive that one.

44 How can you believe, receiving glory from each other, and you do not seek the glory from the only God?

45 Do not suppose that I will accuse you before the Father. There is one accusing you, Moses, in whom you have hoped.

46 For if you believed Moses, you would believe me, for he wrote concerning me.

47 But if you do not believe his writings, how will you believe my sayings?

Chapter 6

1 After these things Jesus went away beyond the sea of Galilee, of Tiberias.

2 And a great crowd was following him, because they were seeing his signs which he was doing upon the sick.

3 And Jesus went up into the mountain, and there was sitting with his disciples.

4 And the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was near.

5 Jesus therefore, having lifted his eyes and having beheld that a great crowd comes to him, says to Philip, From where shall we buy breads so that these may eat?

6 And he was saying this testing him, for he himself knew what he was about to do.

7 Philip answered him, Breads of two hundred denarii are not enough for them, so that each of them may receive a little.

8 One of his disciples, Andrew, the brother of Simon Peter, says to him,

9 There is one little boy here who has five barley breads and two small fish, but what are these for so many?

10 And Jesus said, Make the people recline. And there was much grass in the place. The men therefore reclined, about five thousand in number.

11 And Jesus took the breads, and having given thanks, distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those reclining; likewise also from the small fish, as much as they wished.

12 And when they were filled, he says to his disciples, Gather the fragments that remained over, so that nothing may perish.

13 They therefore gathered and filled twelve baskets with fragments from the five barley breads, which remained over to those who had eaten.

14 The people therefore, having seen the sign which Jesus did, were saying that this is truly the Prophet coming into the world.

15 Jesus therefore, having known that they are about to come and seize him so that they may make him king, withdrew again into the mountain, himself alone.

16 And when evening came, his disciples went down to the sea,

17 and having entered into the boat, were coming beyond the sea to Capernaum. And darkness had already come, and Jesus had not come to them.

18 And the sea was being stirred up, a great wind blowing.

19 Having therefore rowed about twenty-five or thirty stadia, they behold Jesus walking upon the sea and coming near the boat, and they were afraid.

20 But he says to them, I am; do not fear.

21 They therefore wished to receive him into the boat, and immediately the boat came to the land to which they were going.

22 On the next day the crowd standing beyond the sea, having seen that no other little boat was there except that one into which his disciples entered, and that Jesus did not enter together with his disciples into the little boat, but his disciples alone went away,

23 but other little boats came from Tiberias near the place where they ate the bread after the Lord had given thanks,

24 when therefore the crowd saw that Jesus is not there, nor his disciples, they themselves also entered into the boats and came to Capernaum, seeking Jesus.

25 And having found him beyond the sea, they said to him, Rabbi, when have you come here?

26 Jesus answered them and said, Amen, amen, I say to you, You seek me not because you saw signs, but because you ate from the breads and were filled.

27 Work not for the food that perishes, but for the food that remains into eternal life, which the Son of Man will give you, for him the Father, God, sealed.

28 They therefore said to him, What do we do so that we may work the works of God?

29 Jesus answered and said to them, This is the work of God, that you believe in the one whom he sent.

30 They therefore said to him, What sign therefore do you do, so that we may see and believe you? What do you work?

31 Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness, just as it is written, He gave them bread from heaven to eat.

32 Jesus therefore said to them, Amen, amen, I say to you, Moses has not given you the bread from heaven, but my Father gives you the true bread from heaven.

33 For the bread of God is the one descending from heaven and giving life to the world.

34 They therefore said to him, Lord, always give us this bread.

35 And Jesus said to them, I am the bread of life. The one coming to me will certainly not hunger, and the one believing in me will certainly never thirst.

36 But I said to you that you have both seen me and do not believe.

37 Everything which the Father gives me will come to me, and the one coming to me I will certainly not cast outside.

38 Because I have descended from heaven not so that I may do my own will, but the will of the one who sent me.

39 And this is the will of the Father who sent me, that of everything which he has given me I may lose nothing, but raise it on the last day.

40 And this is the will of the one who sent me, that everyone beholding the Son and believing in him may have eternal life, and I will raise him on the last day.

41 The Jews therefore were murmuring concerning him, because he said, I am the bread that descended from heaven.

42 And they were saying, Is this not Jesus, the son of Joseph, whose father and mother we know? How therefore does this man say, I have descended from heaven?

43 Jesus therefore answered and said to them, Do not murmur with each other.

44 No one can come to me unless the Father who sent me draws him, and I will raise him on the last day.

45 It is written in the prophets, And all will be taught by God. Everyone therefore who heard from the Father and learned comes to me.

46 Not that anyone has seen the Father except the one being from God; he has seen the Father.

47 Amen, amen, I say to you, The one believing in me has eternal life.

48 I am the bread of life.

49 Your fathers ate the manna in the wilderness and died.

50 This is the bread descending from heaven, so that someone may eat from it and not die.

51 I am the living bread that descended from heaven. If anyone eats from this bread, he will live forever. And also the bread which I will give is my flesh, which I will give for the life of the world.

52 The Jews therefore were fighting with each other, saying, How can this man give us his flesh to eat?

53 Jesus therefore said to them, Amen, amen, I say to you, Unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you do not have life in yourselves.

54 The one chewing my flesh and drinking my blood has eternal life, and I will raise him on the last day.

55 For my flesh truly is food, and my blood truly is drink.

56 The one chewing my flesh and drinking my blood remains in me, and I in him.

57 Just as the living Father sent me, and I live because of the Father, also the one chewing me, that one too will live because of me.

58 This is the bread that descended from heaven, not as your fathers ate the manna and died. The one chewing this bread will live forever.

59 He said these things in a synagogue, teaching in Capernaum.

60 Many therefore of his disciples, having heard, said, This word is hard; who can hear it?

61 But Jesus, knowing in himself that his disciples murmur concerning this, said to them, Does this cause you to stumble?

62 If therefore you behold the Son of Man ascending where he was before?

63 The Spirit is the one making alive; the flesh benefits nothing. The sayings which I speak to you are spirit and are life.

64 But there are some of you who do not believe. For Jesus knew from the beginning who are those not believing, and who is the one who will hand him over.

65 And he was saying, Because of this I have said to you that no one can come to me unless it has been given to him from my Father.

66 From this many of his disciples went away backward, and were no longer walking with him.

67 Jesus therefore said to the twelve, You too do not wish to go away, do you?

68 Simon Peter therefore answered him, Lord, to whom shall we go away? You have sayings of eternal life.

69 And we have believed and have known that you are the Christ, the Son of the living God.

70 Jesus answered them, Did I not choose you, the twelve? And one of you is a devil.

71 And he was speaking of Judas Iscariot of Simon, for this man was about to hand him over, being one of the twelve.

Chapter 7

1 And after these things Jesus was walking in Galilee, for he did not wish to walk in Judea, because the Jews were seeking to kill him.

2 And the feast of the Jews, the Tent-pitching, was near.

3 His brothers therefore said to him, Depart from here and go into Judea, so that your disciples also may behold your works which you do.

4 For no one does anything in secret and himself seeks to be in openness. If you do these things, manifest yourself to the world.

5 For not even his brothers were believing in him.

6 Jesus therefore says to them, My time is not yet present, but your time is always ready.

7 The world cannot hate you, but hates me, because I testify concerning it that its works are wicked.

8 You go up to this feast; I do not yet go up to this feast, because my time has not yet been fulfilled.

9 And having said these things to them, he remained in Galilee.

10 But when his brothers went up, then he himself also went up to the feast, not openly, but as in secret.

11 The Jews therefore were seeking him at the feast, and were saying, Where is he?

12 And there was much murmuring concerning him among the crowds. Some were saying that he is good, but others were saying, No, but he leads the crowd astray.

13 Nevertheless no one was speaking openly concerning him because of the fear of the Jews.

14 And when the feast was already at its middle, Jesus went up into the temple and was teaching.

15 And the Jews were marveling, saying, How does this man know letters, not having learned?

16 Jesus answered them and said, My teaching is not mine, but of the one who sent me.

17 If anyone wishes to do his will, he will know concerning the teaching, whether it is from God or I speak from myself.

18 The one speaking from himself seeks his own glory, but the one seeking the glory of the one who sent him, this one is true, and there is no unrighteousness in him.

19 Has Moses not given you the law? And none of you does the law. Why do you seek to kill me?

20 The crowd answered and said, You have a demon. Who seeks to kill you?

21 Jesus answered and said to them, I did one work, and you all marvel.

22 Because of this Moses has given you circumcision, not that it is from Moses, but from the fathers, and on Sabbath you circumcise a person.

23 If a person receives circumcision on Sabbath so that the law of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me because I made a whole person healthy on Sabbath?

24 Do not judge according to appearance, but judge the righteous judgment.

25 Some of the Jerusalemites therefore were saying, Is this not the one whom they seek to kill?

26 And see, he speaks openly, and they say nothing to him. Could the rulers truly have known that this is truly the Christ?

27 But we know this man, from where he is; but when the Christ comes, no one knows from where he is.

28 Jesus therefore cried out in the temple, teaching and saying, You both know me and know from where I am. And I have not come from myself, but the one who sent me is true, whom you do not know.

29 But I know him, because I am from him, and he sent me.

30 They therefore were seeking to seize him, and no one laid a hand upon him, because his hour had not yet come.

31 But many from the crowd believed in him, and were saying, When the Christ comes, will he do more signs than these which this man did?

32 The Pharisees heard the crowd murmuring these things concerning him, and the Pharisees and the chief priests sent officers so that they might seize him.

33 Jesus therefore said to them, I am with you still a little time, and go to the one who sent me.

34 You will seek me and will not find, and where I am you cannot come.

35 The Jews therefore said among themselves, Where is this man about to go, that we will not find him? Is he about to go into the dispersion of the Greeks and teach the Greeks?

36 What is this word which he said, You will seek me and will not find, and where I am you cannot come?

37 And on the last day, the great one of the feast, Jesus stood and cried out, saying, If anyone thirsts, let him come to me and drink.

38 The one believing in me, just as the Scripture said, rivers of living water will flow from his belly.

39 And he said this concerning the Spirit, which those believing in him were about to receive, for there was not yet Holy Spirit, because Jesus was not yet glorified.

40 Many therefore from the crowd, having heard the word, were saying, This is truly the Prophet.

41 Others were saying, This is the Christ. But others were saying, Does the Christ come from Galilee?

42 Did not the Scripture say that the Christ comes from the seed of David and from Bethlehem, the village where David was?

43 A division therefore arose in the crowd because of him.

44 And some of them wished to seize him, but no one laid hands upon him.

45 The officers therefore came to the chief priests and Pharisees, and those said to them, Why did you not bring him?

46 The officers answered, Never did a person speak thus, as this person.

47 The Pharisees therefore answered them, Have you too been led astray?

48 Has anyone from the rulers believed in him, or from the Pharisees?

49 But this crowd, not knowing the law, they are accursed.

50 Nicodemus says to them, the one who came to him by night, being one of them,

51 Does our law judge the person unless it first hears from him and knows what he does?

52 They answered and said to him, Are you too from Galilee? Search and see that a prophet has not arisen from Galilee.

53 And each went to his house.

Chapter 8

1 But Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.

2 And at dawn he came again into the temple, and all the people were coming to him, and having sat down, he was teaching them.

3 And the scribes and the Pharisees bring to him a woman caught in adultery, and having stood her in the midst,

4 they say to him, Teacher, this woman was caught in the very act of committing adultery.

5 And in the law Moses commanded us that such women be stoned. What therefore do you say?

6 And they were saying this testing him, so that they might have something to accuse him of. But Jesus, having bent down, was writing with his finger into the ground.

7 And as they persisted in asking him, having straightened up, he said to them, Let the sinless one of you first throw the stone at her.

8 And again having bent down, he was writing into the ground.

9 But having heard, and being convicted by conscience, they were going out one by one, having begun from the elders to the last, and Jesus was left alone, and the woman standing in the midst.

10 And Jesus, having straightened up and having beheld no one except the woman, said to her, Woman, where are those accusers of yours? Did no one condemn you?

11 And she said, No one, Lord. And Jesus said to her, Neither do I condemn you. Go, and sin no longer.

12 Jesus therefore spoke to them again, saying, I am the light of the world. The one following me will certainly not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life.

13 The Pharisees therefore said to him, You testify concerning yourself; your testimony is not true.

14 Jesus answered and said to them, Even if I testify concerning myself, my testimony is true, because I know from where I came and where I go. But you do not know from where I come and where I go.

15 You judge according to the flesh; I judge no one.

16 And even if I judge, my judgment is true, because I am not alone, but I and the Father who sent me.

17 And in your law also it is written that the testimony of two people is true.

18 I am the one testifying concerning myself, and the Father who sent me testifies concerning me.

19 They therefore were saying to him, Where is your Father? Jesus answered, You know neither me nor my Father. If you knew me, you would also know my Father.

20 Jesus spoke these sayings in the treasury, teaching in the temple, and no one seized him, because his hour had not yet come.

21 Jesus therefore said again to them, I go away, and you will seek me and die in your sin. Where I go, you cannot come.

22 The Jews therefore were saying, Will he kill himself, because he says, Where I go, you cannot come?

23 And he said to them, You are from the things below; I am from the things above. You are from this world; I am not from this world.

24 I therefore said to you that you will die in your sins, for unless you believe that I am, you will die in your sins.

25 They therefore were saying to him, Who are you? And Jesus said to them, From the beginning, what I also speak to you.

26 I have many things to speak and judge concerning you, but the one who sent me is true, and what I heard from him, these things I say to the world.

27 They did not know that he was speaking to them of the Father.

28 Jesus therefore said to them, When you lift up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am, and I do nothing from myself, but just as my Father taught me, these things I speak.

29 And the one who sent me is with me; the Father did not leave me alone, because I always do the things pleasing to him.

30 As he was speaking these things, many believed in him.

31 Jesus therefore was saying to the Jews who had believed him, If you remain in my word, you are truly my disciples,

32 and you will know the truth, and the truth will free you.

33 They answered him, We are Abraham's seed, and have never been enslaved to anyone. How do you say that you will become free?

34 Jesus answered them, Amen, amen, I say to you that everyone doing sin is a slave of sin.

35 And the slave does not remain in the house forever; the son remains forever.

36 If therefore the Son frees you, you will be truly free.

37 I know that you are Abraham's seed, but you seek to kill me, because my word finds no room in you.

38 I speak what I have seen with my Father, and you therefore do what you have seen with your father.

39 They answered and said to him, Our father is Abraham. Jesus says to them, If you were Abraham's children, you would do Abraham's works.

40 But now you seek to kill me, a man who has spoken to you the truth which I heard from God. Abraham did not do this.

41 You do the works of your father. They therefore said to him, We have not been born from fornication; we have one Father, God.

42 Jesus therefore said to them, If God were your Father, you would love me, for I went out from God and have come; for neither have I come from myself, but he sent me.

43 Why do you not know my speech? Because you cannot hear my word.

44 You are from your father the devil, and you wish to do the desires of your father. He was a murderer from the beginning and has not stood in the truth, because there is no truth in him. When he speaks the lie, he speaks from his own things, because he is a liar and its father.

45 But because I say the truth, you do not believe me.

46 Who of you convicts me concerning sin? But if I say truth, why do you not believe me?

47 The one being from God hears the sayings of God. Because of this you do not hear, because you are not from God.

48 The Jews therefore answered and said to him, Do we not say well that you are a Samaritan and have a demon?

49 Jesus answered, I do not have a demon, but honor my Father, and you dishonor me.

50 But I do not seek my glory; there is one seeking and judging.

51 Amen, amen, I say to you, If anyone keeps my word, he will certainly not behold death forever.

52 The Jews therefore said to him, Now we have known that you have a demon. Abraham died, and the prophets, and you say, If anyone keeps my word, he will certainly not taste death forever.

53 You are not greater than our father Abraham, who died, are you? And the prophets died. Whom do you make yourself?

54 Jesus answered, If I glorify myself, my glory is nothing. It is my Father who glorifies me, of whom you say that he is your God.

55 And you have not known him, but I know him. And if I say that I do not know him, I will be like you, a liar. But I know him and keep his word.

56 Abraham your father exulted so that he might see my day, and he saw and rejoiced.

57 The Jews therefore said to him, You do not yet have fifty years, and have you seen Abraham?

58 Jesus said to them, Amen, amen, I say to you, Before Abraham came into being, I am.

59 They therefore took up stones so that they might throw them at him. But Jesus was hidden and went out of the temple, having passed through their midst, and was passing by thus.

Chapter 9

1 And passing by, he saw a person blind from birth.

2 And his disciples asked him, saying, Rabbi, who sinned, this man or his parents, so that he was born blind?

3 Jesus answered, Neither this man sinned nor his parents, but so that the works of God might be manifested in him.

4 I must work the works of the one who sent me while it is day. Night comes, when no one can work.

5 When I am in the world, I am light of the world.

6 Having said these things, he spat on the ground and made clay from the spittle, and smeared the clay upon the eyes of the blind man.

7 And he said to him, Go, wash in the pool of Siloam, which is translated Sent. He therefore went away and washed, and came seeing.

8 The neighbors therefore, and those beholding him before, that he was blind, were saying, Is this not the one sitting and begging?

9 Others were saying that this is he, but others that he is like him. He was saying, I am he.

10 They therefore were saying to him, How were your eyes opened?

11 He answered and said, A man called Jesus made clay and smeared my eyes, and said to me, Go to the pool of Siloam and wash. And having gone away and washed, I received sight.

12 They therefore said to him, Where is he? He says, I do not know.

13 They bring him to the Pharisees, the one formerly blind.

14 And it was Sabbath when Jesus made the clay and opened his eyes.

15 Again therefore the Pharisees also were asking him how he received sight. And he said to them, He placed clay upon my eyes, and I washed, and I see.

16 Some of the Pharisees therefore were saying, This man is not from God, because he does not keep the Sabbath. Others were saying, How can a sinful man do such signs? And there was division among them.

17 They say to the blind man again, What do you say concerning him, because he opened your eyes? And he said that he is a prophet.

18 The Jews therefore did not believe concerning him that he was blind and received sight, until they called his parents, of the one who received sight,

19 and asked them, saying, Is this your son, whom you say was born blind? How therefore does he now see?

20 His parents answered them and said, We know that this is our son, and that he was born blind.

21 But how he now sees we do not know, or who opened his eyes we do not know. He has age; ask him. He will speak concerning himself.

22 His parents said these things because they feared the Jews, for the Jews had already agreed that if anyone confessed him as Christ, he should become expelled from the synagogue.

23 Because of this his parents said, He has age; ask him.

24 They therefore called a second time the man who was blind, and said to him, Give glory to God. We know that this man is sinful.

25 He therefore answered and said, If he is sinful, I do not know. One thing I know, that being blind, now I see.

26 And they said to him again, What did he do to you? How did he open your eyes?

27 He answered them, I told you already, and you did not hear. Why do you wish to hear again? You too do not wish to become his disciples, do you?

28 They therefore reviled him and said, You are that man's disciple, but we are Moses' disciples.

29 We know that God has spoken to Moses, but this man, we do not know from where he is.

30 The man answered and said to them, For in this is the marvelous thing, that you do not know from where he is, and he opened my eyes.

31 And we know that God does not hear sinners, but if anyone is God-revering and does his will, he hears this one.

32 From the age it was not heard that anyone opened the eyes of one born blind.

33 If this man were not from God, he could do nothing.

34 They answered and said to him, You were born wholly in sins, and do you teach us? And they cast him outside.

35 Jesus heard that they cast him outside, and having found him, said to him, Do you believe in the Son of God?

36 He answered and said, Who is he, Lord, so that I may believe in him?

37 And Jesus said to him, You have both seen him, and the one speaking with you is he.

38 And he said, I believe, Lord, and worshiped him.

39 And Jesus said, For judgment I came into this world, so that those not seeing may see, and those seeing may become blind.

40 And those of the Pharisees being with him heard these things and said to him, We too are not blind, are we?

41 Jesus said to them, If you were blind, you would not have sin. But now you say that we see; therefore your sin remains.

Chapter 10

1 Amen, amen, I say to you, The one not entering through the door into the enclosure of the sheep, but climbing up from elsewhere, that one is a thief and a robber.

2 But the one entering through the door is shepherd of the sheep.

3 To him the doorkeeper opens, and the sheep hear his voice, and he calls his own sheep by name and leads them out.

4 And when he brings out his own sheep, he goes before them, and the sheep follow him, because they know his voice.

5 But they will certainly not follow a stranger, but will flee from him, because they do not know the voice of strangers.

6 Jesus said this figure to them, but they did not know what the things were which he was speaking to them.

7 Jesus therefore said again to them, Amen, amen, I say to you that I am the door of the sheep.

8 All who came before me are thieves and robbers, but the sheep did not hear them.

9 I am the door. If anyone enters through me, he will be saved, and will enter and go out and find pasture.

10 The thief does not come except so that he may steal and slaughter and destroy. I came so that they may have life, and have abundance.

11 I am the good shepherd. The good shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.

12 But the hired man, and not being a shepherd, whose sheep are not his own, beholds the wolf coming and leaves the sheep and flees, and the wolf seizes them and scatters the sheep.

13 And the hired man flees because he is a hired man, and he does not care concerning the sheep.

14 I am the good shepherd, and know my own, and am known by my own,

15 just as the Father knows me, and I know the Father; and I lay down my life for the sheep.

16 And I have other sheep which are not from this enclosure. Those also I must bring, and they will hear my voice, and there will be one flock, one shepherd.

17 Because of this the Father loves me, because I lay down my life so that I may take it again.

18 No one takes it from me, but I lay it down from myself. I have authority to lay it down, and I have authority to take it again. This commandment I received from my Father.

19 A division therefore arose again among the Jews because of these words.

20 And many of them were saying, He has a demon and is mad. Why do you hear him?

21 Others were saying, These sayings are not of one demon-possessed. A demon cannot open blind people's eyes, can it?

22 And the Dedication took place in Jerusalem, and it was winter.

23 And Jesus was walking in the temple, in Solomon's portico.

24 The Jews therefore surrounded him and were saying to him, Until when do you keep our soul in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell us openly.

25 Jesus answered them, I told you, and you do not believe. The works which I do in my Father's name, these testify concerning me.

26 But you do not believe, for you are not from my sheep, just as I said to you.

27 My sheep hear my voice, and I know them, and they follow me.

28 And I give them eternal life, and they will certainly not perish forever, and no one will snatch them from my hand.

29 My Father, who has given to me, is greater than all, and no one can snatch from my Father's hand.

30 I and the Father are one.

31 The Jews therefore took up stones again so that they might stone him.

32 Jesus answered them, I showed you many good works from my Father. For which work of them do you stone me?

33 The Jews answered him, saying, We do not stone you concerning a good work, but concerning blasphemy, and because you, being a man, make yourself God.

34 Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, You are gods?

35 If he called those gods to whom the word of God came, and the Scripture cannot be broken,

36 do you say to the one whom the Father sanctified and sent into the world, You blaspheme, because I said, I am Son of God?

37 If I do not do the works of my Father, do not believe me.

38 But if I do, even if you do not believe me, believe the works, so that you may know and believe that the Father is in me, and I in him.

39 They therefore were seeking again to seize him, and he went out from their hand.

40 And he went away again beyond the Jordan, to the place where John was first baptizing, and remained there.

41 And many came to him, and were saying that John indeed did no sign, but all things which John said concerning this man were true.

42 And many believed in him there.

Chapter 11

1 And a certain man was sick, Lazarus from Bethany, from the village of Mary and Martha her sister.

2 And Mary was the one who anointed the Lord with ointment and wiped his feet with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was sick.

3 The sisters therefore sent to him, saying, Lord, see, the one whom you love is sick.

4 And Jesus, having heard, said, This sickness is not toward death, but for the glory of God, so that the Son of God may be glorified through it.

5 And Jesus loved Martha and her sister and Lazarus.

6 When therefore he heard that he is sick, then indeed he stayed two days in the place where he was.

7 Then after this he says to the disciples, Let us go into Judea again.

8 The disciples say to him, Rabbi, just now the Jews were seeking to stone you, and do you go there again?

9 Jesus answered, Are there not twelve hours of the day? If anyone walks in the day, he does not stumble, because he sees the light of this world.

10 But if anyone walks in the night, he stumbles, because the light is not in him.

11 He said these things, and after this says to them, Lazarus our friend has fallen asleep, but I go so that I may awaken him.

12 His disciples therefore said, Lord, if he has fallen asleep, he will be saved.

13 But Jesus had spoken concerning his death, while they supposed that he speaks concerning the resting of sleep.

14 Then therefore Jesus said to them openly, Lazarus died.

15 And I rejoice because of you, so that you may believe, that I was not there. But let us go to him.

16 Thomas therefore, the one called Twin, said to the fellow disciples, Let us also go, so that we may die with him.

17 Having therefore come, Jesus found him already having four days in the tomb.

18 And Bethany was near Jerusalem, about fifteen stadia away.

19 And many of the Jews had come to those around Martha and Mary, so that they might console them concerning their brother.

20 Martha therefore, when she heard that Jesus comes, met him, but Mary was sitting in the house.

21 Martha therefore said to Jesus, Lord, if you were here, my brother would not have died.

22 But even now I know that whatever you ask God, God will give you.

23 Jesus says to her, Your brother will rise.

24 Martha says to him, I know that he will rise in the resurrection on the last day.

25 Jesus said to her, I am the resurrection and the life. The one believing in me, even if he dies, will live.

26 And everyone living and believing in me will certainly not die forever. Do you believe this?

27 She says to him, Yes, Lord, I have believed that you are the Christ, the Son of God, the one coming into the world.

28 And having said these things, she went away and called Mary her sister secretly, saying, The Teacher is present and calls you.

29 When she heard, she rises quickly and comes to him.

30 And Jesus had not yet come into the village, but was in the place where Martha met him.

31 The Jews therefore who were with her in the house and consoling her, having seen Mary, that she rose quickly and went out, followed her, saying that she goes to the tomb so that she may weep there.

32 Mary therefore, when she came where Jesus was, having seen him, fell at his feet, saying to him, Lord, if you were here, my brother would not have died.

33 Jesus therefore, when he saw her weeping, and the Jews who came with her weeping, was indignant in spirit and troubled himself,

34 and said, Where have you placed him? They say to him, Lord, come and see.

35 Jesus shed tears.

36 The Jews therefore were saying, See how he loved him.

37 But some of them said, Could not this man who opened the eyes of the blind man have done so that this man too might not die?

38 Jesus therefore, again being indignant within himself, comes to the tomb. And it was a cave, and a stone lay upon it.

39 Jesus says, Take away the stone. Martha, the sister of the one who has died, says to him, Lord, he already smells, for he is four days dead.

40 Jesus says to her, Did I not say to you that if you believe, you will see the glory of God?

41 They therefore took away the stone where the one who had died was lying. And Jesus lifted his eyes upward and said, Father, I thank you that you heard me.

42 And I knew that you always hear me, but because of the crowd standing around I said it, so that they may believe that you sent me.

43 And having said these things, he cried out with a loud voice, Lazarus, come outside.

44 And the one who had died came out, bound as to feet and hands with bands, and his face had been bound around with a handkerchief. Jesus says to them, Unbind him and allow him to go.

45 Many therefore of the Jews who came to Mary and beheld what Jesus did believed in him.

46 But some of them went away to the Pharisees and told them what Jesus did.

47 The chief priests and the Pharisees therefore gathered a council, and were saying, What do we do, because this man does many signs?

48 If we allow him thus, all will believe in him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and nation.

49 But a certain one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, You know nothing,

50 nor do you consider that it benefits us that one man die for the people, and not the whole nation perish.

51 And he did not say this from himself, but being high priest that year, prophesied that Jesus was about to die for the nation,

52 and not for the nation only, but so that he might also gather into one the children of God who had been scattered.

53 From that day therefore they took counsel so that they might kill him.

54 Jesus therefore was no longer walking openly among the Jews, but went away from there into the country near the wilderness, into a city called Ephraim, and there was spending time with his disciples.

55 And the Passover of the Jews was near, and many went up to Jerusalem from the country before the Passover, so that they might purify themselves.

56 They therefore were seeking Jesus, and were saying with each other, standing in the temple, What do you think, that he will certainly not come to the feast?

57 And both the chief priests and the Pharisees had given a commandment that if anyone knows where he is, he should disclose it, so that they might seize him.

Chapter 12

1 Jesus therefore, six days before the Passover, came into Bethany, where Lazarus was, the one who had died, whom he raised from the dead.

2 They therefore made him a dinner there, and Martha was serving, and Lazarus was one of those reclining together with him.

3 Mary therefore, having taken a pound of ointment of genuine nard, very costly, anointed the feet of Jesus and wiped his feet with her hair. And the house was filled from the smell of the ointment.

4 One of his disciples therefore says, Judas Iscariot of Simon, the one about to hand him over,

5 Why was this ointment not sold for three hundred denarii and given to the poor?

6 And he said this not because he cared concerning the poor, but because he was a thief, and had the money box, and was carrying off the things put in.

7 Jesus therefore said, Allow her; she has kept it for the day of my burial.

8 For you always have the poor with yourselves, but you do not always have me.

9 A great crowd from the Jews therefore knew that he is there, and they came not because of Jesus only, but so that they might also see Lazarus, whom he raised from the dead.

10 But the chief priests took counsel so that they might kill Lazarus also,

11 because many of the Jews were going away because of him and believing in Jesus.

12 On the next day a great crowd that came to the feast, having heard that Jesus comes into Jerusalem,

13 took the branches of the palms and went out to meet him, and were crying out, Hosanna! Blessed is the one coming in the name of the Lord, the King of Israel.

14 And Jesus, having found a little donkey, sat upon it, just as it is written,

15 Do not fear, daughter of Zion; look, your King comes, sitting upon a donkey's colt.

16 But his disciples did not know these things at first; but when Jesus was glorified, then they remembered that these things had been written concerning him, and they did these things to him.

17 The crowd therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus from the tomb and raised him from the dead was testifying.

18 Because of this also the crowd met him, because it heard that he had done this sign.

19 The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, You behold that you benefit nothing. See, the world went away after him.

20 And there were some Greeks from those going up so that they might worship at the feast.

21 These therefore approached Philip, the one from Bethsaida of Galilee, and were asking him, saying, Sir, we wish to see Jesus.

22 Philip comes and tells Andrew, and again Andrew and Philip tell Jesus.

23 And Jesus answered them, saying, The hour has come so that the Son of Man may be glorified.

24 Amen, amen, I say to you, Unless the grain of wheat, having fallen into the earth, dies, it remains alone; but if it dies, it bears much fruit.

25 The one loving his life will lose it, and the one hating his life in this world will guard it into eternal life.

26 If anyone serves me, let him follow me, and where I am, there my servant also will be. And if anyone serves me, the Father will honor him.

27 Now my soul has been troubled, and what shall I say? Father, save me from this hour? But because of this I came into this hour.

28 Father, glorify your name. A voice therefore came from heaven, I both glorified it and will glorify it again.

29 The crowd therefore standing and having heard was saying that thunder had happened. Others were saying, An angel has spoken to him.

30 Jesus answered and said, This voice has come not because of me, but because of you.

31 Now is judgment of this world; now the ruler of this world will be cast outside.

32 And I, if I am lifted up from the earth, will draw all to myself.

33 And he was saying this signifying by what death he was about to die.

34 The crowd answered him, We heard from the law that the Christ remains forever, and how do you say that the Son of Man must be lifted up? Who is this Son of Man?

35 Jesus therefore said to them, The light is with you still a little time. Walk while you have the light, so that darkness may not overtake you; and the one walking in the darkness does not know where he goes.

36 While you have the light, believe in the light, so that you may become sons of light. Jesus spoke these things, and having gone away, was hidden from them.

37 But though he had done so many signs before them, they were not believing in him,

38 so that the word of Isaiah the prophet might be fulfilled which he said, Lord, who believed our report? And to whom was the arm of the Lord revealed?

39 Because of this they could not believe, because Isaiah said again,

40 He has blinded their eyes and has hardened their heart, so that they may not see with the eyes and understand with the heart and turn back, and I may heal them.

41 Isaiah said these things when he saw his glory and spoke concerning him.

42 Nevertheless, however, many even from the rulers believed in him, but because of the Pharisees they were not confessing, so that they might not become expelled from the synagogue.

43 For they loved the glory of people rather than the glory of God.

44 And Jesus cried out and said, The one believing in me does not believe in me, but in the one who sent me.

45 And the one beholding me beholds the one who sent me.

46 I have come as light into the world, so that everyone believing in me may not remain in the darkness.

47 And if anyone hears my sayings and does not believe, I do not judge him, for I did not come so that I might judge the world, but so that I might save the world.

48 The one rejecting me and not receiving my sayings has the one judging him. The word which I spoke, that will judge him on the last day.

49 Because I did not speak from myself, but the Father who sent me, he gave me a commandment, what I should say and what I should speak.

50 And I know that his commandment is eternal life. The things therefore which I speak, just as the Father has said to me, thus I speak.

Chapter 13

1 And before the feast of the Passover, Jesus, knowing that his hour has come so that he may pass from this world to the Father, having loved his own who were in the world, loved them to the end.

2 And dinner having taken place, the devil having already put into the heart of Judas Iscariot of Simon that he should hand him over,

3 Jesus, knowing that the Father has given all things to him into his hands, and that he went out from God and goes to God,

4 rises from the dinner and lays down the garments, and having taken a towel, girded himself.

5 Then he puts water into the basin and began to wash the feet of the disciples and wipe them with the towel with which he was girded.

6 He comes therefore to Simon Peter, and he says to him, Lord, do you wash my feet?

7 Jesus answered and said to him, What I do you do not know now, but you will know after these things.

8 Peter says to him, You will certainly not wash my feet forever. Jesus answered him, Unless I wash you, you have no part with me.

9 Simon Peter says to him, Lord, not my feet only, but also the hands and the head.

10 Jesus says to him, The one who has bathed has no need except to wash the feet, but is wholly clean. And you are clean, but not all.

11 For he knew the one handing him over; because of this he said, You are not all clean.

12 When therefore he washed their feet and took his garments, having reclined again, he said to them, Do you know what I have done to you?

13 You call me the Teacher and the Lord, and you say well, for I am.

14 If therefore I, the Lord and the Teacher, washed your feet, you also owe to wash each other's feet.

15 For I gave you an example, so that just as I did to you, you also may do.

16 Amen, amen, I say to you, A slave is not greater than his master, nor a messenger greater than the one who sent him.

17 If you know these things, you are blessed if you do them.

18 I do not speak concerning all of you; I know whom I chose. But so that the Scripture may be fulfilled, The one chewing the bread with me lifted his heel against me.

19 From now I tell you before it happens, so that when it happens, you may believe that I am.

20 Amen, amen, I say to you, The one receiving whomever I may send receives me, and the one receiving me receives the one who sent me.

21 Having said these things, Jesus was troubled in spirit, and testified and said, Amen, amen, I say to you that one of you will hand me over.

22 The disciples therefore were looking at each other, being perplexed concerning whom he speaks.

23 And one of his disciples was reclining in the bosom of Jesus, whom Jesus loved.

24 Simon Peter therefore motions to this one to inquire who it might be concerning whom he speaks.

25 And he, having leaned upon the chest of Jesus, says to him, Lord, who is it?

26 Jesus answers, It is he to whom I, having dipped the morsel, will give it. And having dipped the morsel, he gives it to Judas Iscariot of Simon.

27 And after the morsel, then Satan entered into him. Jesus therefore says to him, What you do, do more quickly.

28 But no one of those reclining knew for what he said this to him.

29 For some were supposing, since Judas had the money box, that Jesus says to him, Buy the things of which we have need for the feast, or that he should give something to the poor.

30 Having therefore received the morsel, he immediately went out. And it was night.

31 When he went out, Jesus says, Now the Son of Man was glorified, and God was glorified in him.

32 If God was glorified in him, God also will glorify him in himself, and will glorify him immediately.

33 Little children, I am with you still a little while. You will seek me, and just as I said to the Jews, Where I go you cannot come, also to you I say it now.

34 I give you a new commandment, that you love each other, just as I loved you, that you also love each other.

35 In this all will know that you are my disciples, if you have love among each other.

36 Simon Peter says to him, Lord, where do you go? Jesus answered him, Where I go, you cannot follow me now, but later you will follow me.

37 Peter says to him, Lord, why can I not follow you now? I will lay down my life for you.

38 Jesus answered him, Will you lay down your life for me? Amen, amen, I say to you, A rooster will certainly not call until you deny me three times.

Chapter 14

1 Let not your heart be troubled. Believe in God, and believe in me.

2 In my Father's house are many dwelling places. But if not, I would have told you. I go to prepare a place for you.

3 And if I go and prepare a place for you, I come again and will receive you to myself, so that where I am, you also may be.

4 And where I go you know, and the way you know.

5 Thomas says to him, Lord, we do not know where you go, and how can we know the way?

6 Jesus says to him, I am the way and the truth and the life. No one comes to the Father except through me.

7 If you had known me, you would also have known my Father. And from now you know him and have seen him.

8 Philip says to him, Lord, show us the Father, and it suffices for us.

9 Jesus says to him, I am with you so much time, and have you not known me, Philip? The one who has seen me has seen the Father, and how do you say, Show us the Father?

10 Do you not believe that I am in the Father and the Father is in me? The sayings which I speak to you I do not speak from myself, but the Father remaining in me, he does the works.

11 Believe me that I am in the Father and the Father in me; but if not, believe me because of the works themselves.

12 Amen, amen, I say to you, The one believing in me, that one too will do the works which I do, and will do greater things than these, because I go to my Father.

13 And whatever you ask in my name, this I will do, so that the Father may be glorified in the Son.

14 If you ask anything in my name, I will do it.

15 If you love me, keep my commandments.

16 And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another Advocate, so that he may remain with you forever,

17 the Spirit of truth, whom the world cannot receive, because it does not behold him nor know him. But you know him, because he remains with you and will be in you.

18 I will not leave you orphans; I come to you.

19 Still a little while, and the world no longer beholds me, but you behold me. Because I live, you also will live.

20 On that day you will know that I am in my Father, and you in me, and I in you.

21 The one having my commandments and keeping them, he is the one loving me. And the one loving me will be loved by my Father, and I will love him and manifest myself to him.

22 Judas, not the Iscariot, says to him, Lord, what has happened, that you are about to manifest yourself to us and not to the world?

23 Jesus answered and said to him, If anyone loves me, he will keep my word, and my Father will love him, and we will come to him and make a dwelling place with him.

24 The one not loving me does not keep my words, and the word which you hear is not mine, but of the Father who sent me.

25 I have spoken these things to you, remaining with you.

26 But the Advocate, the Holy Spirit, whom the Father will send in my name, he will teach you all things and remind you of all things which I said to you.

27 I leave peace to you; I give my peace to you. Not just as the world gives do I give to you. Let not your heart be troubled, nor let it be cowardly.

28 You heard that I said to you, I go away and come to you. If you loved me, you would have rejoiced because I said, I go to the Father, because my Father is greater than I.

29 And now I have told you before it happens, so that when it happens, you may believe.

30 I will no longer speak many things with you, for the ruler of this world comes, and has nothing in me.

31 But so that the world may know that I love the Father, and just as the Father commanded me, thus I do. Rise, let us go from here.

Chapter 15

1 I am the true vine, and my Father is the farmer.

2 Every branch in me not bearing fruit, he takes it away, and every one bearing fruit, he cleans it, so that it may bear more fruit.

3 You are already clean because of the word which I have spoken to you.

4 Remain in me, and I in you. Just as the branch cannot bear fruit from itself unless it remains in the vine, thus neither can you unless you remain in me.

5 I am the vine; you the branches. The one remaining in me, and I in him, this one bears much fruit, because apart from me you can do nothing.

6 If anyone does not remain in me, he was cast outside as the branch and was withered, and they gather them and cast into fire, and it is burned.

7 If you remain in me and my sayings remain in you, whatever you wish you will ask, and it will happen for you.

8 In this my Father was glorified, that you bear much fruit, and you will become my disciples.

9 Just as the Father loved me, I also loved you. Remain in my love.

10 If you keep my commandments, you will remain in my love, just as I have kept my Father's commandments and remain in his love.

11 I have spoken these things to you so that my joy may remain in you and your joy may be fulfilled.

12 This is my commandment, that you love each other just as I loved you.

13 No one has greater love than this, that someone lay down his life for his friends.

14 You are my friends if you do whatever I command you.

15 I no longer call you slaves, because the slave does not know what his master does, but I have called you friends, because all things which I heard from my Father I made known to you.

16 You did not choose me, but I chose you and appointed you, so that you may go and bear fruit and your fruit may remain, so that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he may give you.

17 These things I command you, that you love each other.

18 If the world hates you, know that it has hated me before you.

19 If you were from the world, the world would love its own. But because you are not from the world, but I chose you out of the world, because of this the world hates you.

20 Remember the word which I said to you, A slave is not greater than his master. If they persecuted me, they will also persecute you; if they kept my word, they will also keep yours.

21 But they will do all these things to you because of my name, because they do not know the one who sent me.

22 If I had not come and spoken to them, they would not have sin. But now they have no excuse concerning their sin.

23 The one hating me also hates my Father.

24 If I had not done among them the works which no other has done, they would not have sin. But now they have both seen and hated both me and my Father.

25 But so that the word written in their law may be fulfilled, They hated me without cause.

26 But when the Advocate comes, whom I will send you from the Father, the Spirit of truth who proceeds from the Father, he will testify concerning me.

27 And you also testify, because you are with me from the beginning.

Chapter 16

1 I have spoken these things to you so that you may not be caused to stumble.

2 They will make you expelled from the synagogue. But an hour comes so that everyone who kills you may suppose he offers worship to God.

3 And they will do these things to you because they did not know the Father nor me.

4 But I have spoken these things to you so that when the hour comes, you may remember them, that I told you. And I did not tell you these things from the beginning, because I was with you.

5 But now I go to the one who sent me, and none of you asks me, Where do you go?

6 But because I have spoken these things to you, sorrow has filled your heart.

7 But I say the truth to you, It benefits you that I go away. For unless I go away, the Advocate will not come to you; but if I go, I will send him to you.

8 And having come, he will convict the world concerning sin and concerning righteousness and concerning judgment:

9 concerning sin indeed, because they do not believe in me;

10 and concerning righteousness, because I go to my Father and you no longer behold me;

11 and concerning judgment, because the ruler of this world has been judged.

12 I still have many things to say to you, but you cannot bear them now.

13 But when he comes, the Spirit of truth, he will guide you into all the truth. For he will not speak from himself, but whatever he hears he will speak, and he will announce to you the coming things.

14 He will glorify me, because he will receive from what is mine and announce it to you.

15 All things which the Father has are mine. Because of this I said that he will receive from what is mine and announce it to you.

16 A little while, and you do not behold me, and again a little while, and you will see me, because I go to the Father.

17 Some of his disciples therefore said to each other, What is this which he says to us, A little while, and you do not behold me, and again a little while, and you will see me, and, Because I go to the Father?

18 They therefore were saying, What is this which he says, The little while? We do not know what he speaks.

19 Jesus therefore knew that they wished to ask him, and said to them, Do you inquire with each other concerning this, because I said, A little while, and you do not behold me, and again a little while, and you will see me?

20 Amen, amen, I say to you that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. And you will be grieved, but your sorrow will become joy.

21 The woman, when she gives birth, has sorrow, because her hour came. But when she bears the child, she no longer remembers the affliction because of the joy that a person was born into the world.

22 And you therefore indeed have sorrow now, but I will see you again, and your heart will rejoice, and no one takes your joy from you.

23 And on that day you will ask me nothing. Amen, amen, I say to you that whatever you ask the Father in my name, he will give you.

24 Until now you asked nothing in my name. Ask, and you will receive, so that your joy may be fulfilled.

25 I have spoken these things to you in figures, but an hour comes when I will no longer speak to you in figures, but will announce to you openly concerning the Father.

26 On that day you will ask in my name, and I do not say to you that I will ask the Father concerning you.

27 For the Father himself loves you, because you have loved me and have believed that I went out from God.

28 I went out from the Father and have come into the world. Again I leave the world and go to the Father.

29 His disciples say to him, See, now you speak openly and say no figure.

30 Now we know that you know all things and have no need that anyone ask you. In this we believe that you went out from God.

31 Jesus answered them, Do you believe now?

32 Look, an hour comes, and has now come, so that you may be scattered, each to his own things, and leave me alone. And I am not alone, because the Father is with me.

33 I have spoken these things to you so that in me you may have peace. In the world you have affliction, but take courage; I have conquered the world.

Chapter 17

1 Jesus spoke these things, and lifted his eyes to heaven and said, Father, the hour has come. Glorify your Son, so that your Son also may glorify you,

2 just as you gave him authority over all flesh, so that everything which you have given him, he may give them eternal life.

3 And this is eternal life, that they know you, the only true God, and the one whom you sent, Jesus Christ.

4 I glorified you upon the earth; I completed the work which you have given me so that I may do it.

5 And now you, Father, glorify me with yourself, with the glory which I had with you before the world was.

6 I manifested your name to the people whom you have given me from the world. They were yours, and you have given them to me, and they have kept your word.

7 Now they have known that all things which you have given me are from you.

8 Because the sayings which you have given me I have given them, and they received and truly knew that I went out from you, and believed that you sent me.

9 I ask concerning them. I do not ask concerning the world, but concerning those whom you have given me, because they are yours.

10 And all my things are yours, and your things mine, and I have been glorified in them.

11 And I am no longer in the world, and these are in the world, and I come to you. Holy Father, keep them in your name, those whom you have given me, so that they may be one just as we.

12 When I was with them in the world, I was keeping them in your name. Those whom you have given me I guarded, and none of them perished except the son of destruction, so that the Scripture may be fulfilled.

13 But now I come to you, and speak these things in the world, so that they may have my joy fulfilled in themselves.

14 I have given them your word, and the world hated them because they are not from the world, just as I am not from the world.

15 I do not ask that you take them out of the world, but that you keep them from the evil one.

16 They are not from the world, just as I am not from the world.

17 Sanctify them in your truth; your word is truth.

18 Just as you sent me into the world, I also sent them into the world.

19 And for them I sanctify myself, so that they also may be sanctified in truth.

20 And I ask not concerning these only, but also concerning those who will believe in me through their word,

21 so that all may be one, just as you, Father, in me, and I in you, so that they also may be one in us, so that the world may believe that you sent me.

22 And I have given them the glory which you have given me, so that they may be one just as we are one.

23 I in them, and you in me, so that they may be perfected into one, and so that the world may know that you sent me and loved them just as you loved me.

24 Father, those whom you have given me, I wish that where I am, they too may be with me, so that they may behold my glory which you gave me, because you loved me before the foundation of the world.

25 Righteous Father, even the world did not know you, but I knew you, and these knew that you sent me.

26 And I made known to them your name, and will make it known, so that the love with which you loved me may be in them, and I in them.

Chapter 18

1 Having said these things, Jesus went out with his disciples beyond the winter torrent of Kedron, where there was a garden, into which he entered and his disciples.

2 And Judas also, the one handing him over, knew the place, because Jesus often gathered there with his disciples.

3 Judas therefore, having received the cohort and officers from the chief priests and Pharisees, comes there with lanterns and torches and weapons.

4 Jesus therefore, knowing all things coming upon him, having gone out, said to them, Whom do you seek?

5 They answered him, Jesus the Nazarene. Jesus says to them, I am. And Judas also, the one handing him over, stood with them.

6 When therefore he said to them, I am, they went backward and fell to the ground.

7 Again therefore he asked them, Whom do you seek? And they said, Jesus the Nazarene.

8 Jesus answered, I told you that I am. If therefore you seek me, allow these to go,

9 so that the word which he said might be fulfilled, Those whom you have given me, I lost none of them.

10 Simon Peter therefore, having a sword, drew it and struck the slave of the high priest, and cut off his right ear. And the slave's name was Malchus.

11 Jesus therefore said to Peter, Put your sword into the sheath. The cup which the Father has given me, shall I not drink it?

12 The cohort therefore, and the commander of a thousand and the officers of the Jews, seized Jesus and bound him,

13 and led him away to Annas first, for he was father-in-law of Caiaphas, who was high priest that year.

14 And Caiaphas was the one who advised the Jews that it benefits them that one man perish for the people.

15 And Simon Peter was following Jesus, and the other disciple. And that disciple was known to the high priest, and entered together with Jesus into the courtyard of the high priest.

16 But Peter stood at the door outside. The other disciple therefore, who was known to the high priest, went out and spoke to the doorkeeper, and brought Peter in.

17 The servant girl, the doorkeeper, therefore says to Peter, You too are not from the disciples of this man, are you? He says, I am not.

18 And the slaves and the officers stood, having made a charcoal fire, because it was cold, and were warming themselves. And Peter was with them, standing and warming himself.

19 The high priest therefore asked Jesus concerning his disciples and concerning his teaching.

20 Jesus answered him, I spoke openly to the world. I always taught in the synagogue and in the temple, where the Jews always gather, and in secret I spoke nothing.

21 Why do you question me? Question those who have heard what I spoke to them. See, these know what I said.

22 And as he said these things, one of the officers standing by gave Jesus a slap, saying, Do you answer the high priest thus?

23 Jesus answered him, If I spoke badly, testify concerning the bad; but if well, why do you beat me?

24 Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas the high priest.

25 And Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They therefore said to him, You too are not from his disciples, are you? He denied and said, I am not.

26 One of the slaves of the high priest says, being a relative of the one whose ear Peter cut off, Did I not see you in the garden with him?

27 Peter therefore denied again, and immediately a rooster called.

28 They therefore lead Jesus from Caiaphas into the praetorium. And it was early morning, and they themselves did not enter into the praetorium, so that they might not be defiled, but so that they might eat the Passover.

29 Pilate therefore went out to them and said, What accusation do you bring against this man?

30 They answered and said to him, If this man were not an evildoer, we would not have handed him over to you.

31 Pilate therefore said to them, You take him, and judge him according to your law. The Jews therefore said to him, It is not lawful for us to kill anyone,

32 so that the word of Jesus might be fulfilled which he said, signifying by what death he was about to die.

33 Pilate therefore entered into the praetorium again and called Jesus, and said to him, Are you the King of the Jews?

34 Jesus answered him, Do you say this from yourself, or did others tell you concerning me?

35 Pilate answered, I am not a Jew, am I? Your nation and the chief priests handed you over to me. What did you do?

36 Jesus answered, My kingdom is not from this world. If my kingdom were from this world, my officers would be fighting so that I might not be handed over to the Jews. But now my kingdom is not from here.

37 Pilate therefore said to him, Therefore are you a king? Jesus answered, You say that I am a king. For this I have been born, and for this I have come into the world, so that I may testify to the truth. Everyone being from the truth hears my voice.

38 Pilate says to him, What is truth? And having said this, he went out again to the Jews and says to them, I find no fault in him.

39 And you have a custom that I release one to you at the Passover. Do you therefore wish that I release to you the King of the Jews?

40 All therefore cried out again, saying, Not this man, but Barabbas. And Barabbas was a robber.

Chapter 19

1 Then therefore Pilate took Jesus and scourged him.

2 And the soldiers, having woven a crown from thorns, placed it upon his head, and clothed him in a purple garment.

3 And they were saying, Hail, King of the Jews, and were giving him slaps.

4 Pilate therefore went outside again and says to them, See, I bring him outside to you, so that you may know that I find no fault in him.

5 Jesus therefore went outside, wearing the thorny crown and the purple garment. And he says to them, See, the man.

6 When therefore the chief priests and the officers saw him, they cried out, saying, Crucify, crucify. Pilate says to them, You take him and crucify, for I do not find fault in him.

7 The Jews answered him, We have a law, and according to our law he owes to die, because he made himself Son of God.

8 When therefore Pilate heard this word, he feared more,

9 and entered into the praetorium again and says to Jesus, From where are you? But Jesus gave him no answer.

10 Pilate therefore says to him, Do you not speak to me? Do you not know that I have authority to crucify you, and have authority to release you?

11 Jesus answered, You would have no authority against me unless it had been given you from above. Because of this the one handing me over to you has greater sin.

12 From this Pilate was seeking to release him, but the Jews were crying out, saying, If you release this man, you are not Caesar's friend. Everyone making himself king speaks against Caesar.

13 Pilate therefore, having heard this word, brought Jesus outside, and sat upon the judgment seat, at a place called Stone-paved, but in Hebrew Gabbatha.

14 And it was Preparation of the Passover, and about the sixth hour. And he says to the Jews, See, your King.

15 But they cried out, Take away, take away, crucify him. Pilate says to them, Shall I crucify your King? The chief priests answered, We have no king except Caesar.

16 Then therefore he handed him over to them so that he might be crucified. And they received Jesus and led him away.

17 And carrying his cross, he went out to the place called Place of a Skull, which is called in Hebrew Golgotha,

18 where they crucified him, and with him two others, on this side and on that side, and Jesus in the middle.

19 And Pilate also wrote a title and placed it upon the cross. And it was written, Jesus the Nazarene, the King of the Jews.

20 Many of the Jews therefore read this title, because the place where Jesus was crucified was near the city, and it was written in Hebrew, Greek, Roman.

21 The chief priests of the Jews therefore were saying to Pilate, Do not write, The King of the Jews, but that he said, I am King of the Jews.

22 Pilate answered, What I have written, I have written.

23 The soldiers therefore, when they crucified Jesus, took his garments and made four parts, to each soldier a part, and the tunic. And the tunic was seamless, woven from the top throughout.

24 They therefore said to each other, Let us not tear it, but cast lots concerning it, whose it will be, so that the Scripture may be fulfilled which says, They divided my garments among themselves, and upon my clothing they cast a lot. The soldiers therefore indeed did these things.

25 And by the cross of Jesus stood his mother, and his mother's sister, Mary of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.

26 Jesus therefore, having seen the mother and the disciple standing by whom he loved, says to his mother, Woman, look, your son.

27 Then he says to the disciple, Look, your mother. And from that hour the disciple received her into his own things.

28 After this, Jesus, knowing that all things have already been completed, so that the Scripture may be completed, says, I thirst.

29 A vessel therefore lay full of vinegar, and they, having filled a sponge with vinegar and having put it around hyssop, brought it to his mouth.

30 When therefore Jesus received the vinegar, he said, It has been completed. And having bowed the head, he handed over the spirit.

31 The Jews therefore, so that the bodies might not remain upon the cross on the Sabbath, since it was Preparation, for the day of that Sabbath was great, asked Pilate that their legs be broken and they be taken away.

32 The soldiers therefore came and broke the legs of the first and of the other crucified with him.

33 But having come to Jesus, when they saw him already dead, they did not break his legs.

34 But one of the soldiers pierced his side with a spear, and immediately blood and water came out.

35 And the one who has seen has testified, and his testimony is true, and he knows that he says true things, so that you may believe.

36 For these things happened so that the Scripture may be fulfilled, A bone of him will not be broken.

37 And again another Scripture says, They will look upon the one whom they pierced.

38 And after these things Joseph from Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but hidden because of the fear of the Jews, asked Pilate that he might take away the body of Jesus, and Pilate permitted. He therefore came and took away the body of Jesus.

39 And Nicodemus also came, the one who came to Jesus by night at first, carrying a mixture of myrrh and aloe, about a hundred pounds.

40 They therefore took the body of Jesus and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, just as it is a custom for the Jews to bury.

41 And in the place where he was crucified there was a garden, and in the garden a new tomb, in which no one had yet been placed.

42 There therefore, because of the Preparation of the Jews, because the tomb was near, they placed Jesus.

Chapter 20

1 And on the first day of the week Mary Magdalene comes early, darkness still being, to the tomb, and sees the stone taken away from the tomb.

2 She therefore runs and comes to Simon Peter and to the other disciple whom Jesus loved, and says to them, They took the Lord away from the tomb, and we do not know where they placed him.

3 Peter therefore went out, and the other disciple, and they were coming to the tomb.

4 And the two were running together, and the other disciple ran ahead more quickly than Peter and came first to the tomb.

5 And having stooped to look, he sees the linen cloths lying; nevertheless he did not enter.

6 Simon Peter therefore comes, following him, and entered into the tomb, and beholds the linen cloths lying,

7 and the handkerchief which was upon his head, not lying with the linen cloths, but apart, wrapped up in one place.

8 Then therefore the other disciple also entered, the one who came first to the tomb, and saw and believed.

9 For they did not yet know the Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.

10 The disciples therefore went away again to themselves.

11 But Mary stood at the tomb, weeping outside. As therefore she was weeping, she stooped to look into the tomb,

12 and beholds two angels in white sitting, one toward the head and one toward the feet, where the body of Jesus was lying.

13 And they say to her, Woman, why do you weep? She says to them, Because they took away my Lord, and I do not know where they placed him.

14 And having said these things, she turned backward and beholds Jesus standing, and did not know that it is Jesus.

15 Jesus says to her, Woman, why do you weep? Whom do you seek? She, supposing that he is the gardener, says to him, Sir, if you carried him away, tell me where you placed him, and I will take him away.

16 Jesus says to her, Mary. She, having turned, says to him, Rabbouni, which is said, Teacher.

17 Jesus says to her, Do not touch me, for I have not yet ascended to my Father. But go to my brothers and tell them, I ascend to my Father and your Father, and my God and your God.

18 Mary Magdalene comes, reporting to the disciples that she has seen the Lord, and he said these things to her.

19 Evening therefore being on that day, the first of the week, and the doors having been shut where the disciples were gathered because of the fear of the Jews, Jesus came and stood in the midst and says to them, Peace to you.

20 And having said this, he showed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore rejoiced, having seen the Lord.

21 Jesus therefore said to them again, Peace to you. Just as the Father has sent me, I also send you.

22 And having said this, he breathed upon them and says to them, Receive Holy Spirit.

23 If you forgive the sins of any, they are forgiven them; if you retain those of any, they have been retained.

24 But Thomas, one of the twelve, the one called Twin, was not with them when Jesus came.

25 The other disciples therefore were saying to him, We have seen the Lord. But he said to them, Unless I see in his hands the mark of the nails, and put my finger into the mark of the nails, and put my hand into his side, I will certainly not believe.

26 And after eight days his disciples were inside again, and Thomas with them. Jesus comes, the doors having been shut, and stood in the midst and said, Peace to you.

27 Then he says to Thomas, Bring your finger here and see my hands, and bring your hand and put it into my side, and do not become unbelieving, but believing.

28 And Thomas answered and said to him, My Lord and my God.

29 Jesus says to him, Because you have seen me, Thomas, you have believed. Blessed are those who did not see and believed.

30 Many therefore indeed other signs also Jesus did before his disciples, which are not written in this book.

31 But these have been written so that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and so that believing you may have life in his name.

Chapter 21

1 After these things Jesus manifested himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias, and manifested himself thus.

2 Simon Peter and Thomas the one called Twin, and Nathanael from Cana of Galilee, and those of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples were together.

3 Simon Peter says to them, I go to fish. They say to him, We too come with you. They went out and immediately went up into the boat, and on that night caught nothing.

4 And early morning having already come, Jesus stood on the shore; nevertheless the disciples did not know that it is Jesus.

5 Jesus therefore says to them, Children, you do not have any food to eat with bread, do you? They answered him, No.

6 And he said to them, Cast the net into the right parts of the boat, and you will find. They therefore cast, and were no longer strong enough to draw it because of the multitude of the fish.

7 That disciple therefore whom Jesus loved says to Peter, It is the Lord. Simon Peter therefore, having heard that it is the Lord, girded on the outer garment, for he was naked, and cast himself into the sea.

8 And the other disciples came by the little boat, for they were not far from the land, but about two hundred cubits away, dragging the net of the fish.

9 When therefore they stepped off onto the land, they see a charcoal fire lying, and a small fish lying upon it, and bread.

10 Jesus says to them, Bring from the small fish which you caught now.

11 Simon Peter went up and drew the net upon the land, full of large fish, one hundred fifty-three; and though there were so many, the net was not torn.

12 Jesus says to them, Come, breakfast. And none of the disciples dared to question him, Who are you? knowing that it is the Lord.

13 Jesus therefore comes and takes the bread and gives to them, and the small fish likewise.

14 This was already the third time Jesus was manifested to his disciples, having been raised from the dead.

15 When therefore they breakfasted, Jesus says to Simon Peter, Simon of Jonah, do you love me more than these? He says to him, Yes, Lord, you know that I love you. He says to him, Feed my lambs.

16 He says to him again a second time, Simon of Jonah, do you love me? He says to him, Yes, Lord, you know that I love you. He says to him, Shepherd my sheep.

17 He says to him the third time, Simon of Jonah, do you love me? Peter was grieved because he said to him the third time, Do you love me? And he said to him, Lord, you know all things; you know that I love you. Jesus says to him, Feed my sheep.

18 Amen, amen, I say to you, When you were younger, you were girding yourself and walking where you wished. But when you grow old, you will stretch out your hands, and another will gird you and carry you where you do not wish.

19 And he said this signifying by what death he will glorify God. And having said this, he says to him, Follow me.

20 And Peter, having turned back, sees the disciple whom Jesus loved following, who also reclined at the dinner upon his chest and said, Lord, who is the one handing you over?

21 Peter, having seen this man, says to Jesus, Lord, and this man, what?

22 Jesus says to him, If I wish him to remain until I come, what is it to you? You follow me.

23 This word therefore went out among the brothers, that that disciple does not die. And Jesus did not say to him that he does not die, but, If I wish him to remain until I come, what is it to you?

24 This is the disciple testifying concerning these things and having written these things, and we know that his testimony is true.

25 And there are also many other things which Jesus did, which, if they are written one by one, I suppose not even the world itself to contain the books being written. Amen.

The Acts

Chapter 1

1 The first account indeed I made concerning all things, O Theophilus, which Jesus began both to do and to teach,

2 until the day on which, having commanded through Holy Spirit the apostles whom he chose, he was taken up.

3 To them also he presented himself alive after he suffered, with many proofs, appearing to them through forty days and speaking the things concerning the kingdom of God.

4 And assembling together, he commanded them not to depart from Jerusalem, but to await the promise of the Father, which you heard from me.

5 Because John indeed baptized with water, but you will be baptized in Holy Spirit not after many of these days.

6 Those therefore who came together were asking him, saying, Lord, do you at this time restore the kingdom to Israel?

7 And he said to them, It is not yours to know times or seasons which the Father set in his own authority.

8 But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you, and you will be witnesses to me both in Jerusalem and in all Judea and Samaria and as far as the end of the earth.

9 And having said these things, while they were looking, he was lifted up, and a cloud received him from their eyes.

10 And as they were looking intently into heaven while he was going, look, two men stood by them in white clothing,

11 who also said, Men of Galilee, why do you stand looking into heaven? This Jesus, who was taken up from you into heaven, will come thus, in the manner you beheld him going into heaven.

12 Then they returned to Jerusalem from the mountain called Olivet, which is near Jerusalem, having a Sabbath's journey.

13 And when they entered, they went up into the upper room where they were staying, both Peter and James and John and Andrew, Philip and Thomas, Bartholomew and Matthew, James of Alphaeus and Simon the Zealot and Judas of James.

14 All these were persevering with one accord in prayer and supplication, with women and Mary the mother of Jesus, and with his brothers.

15 And in these days Peter, having risen in the midst of the disciples, said, and the crowd of names together was about a hundred twenty,

16 Men, brothers, this Scripture had to be fulfilled, which the Holy Spirit spoke beforehand through David's mouth concerning Judas, who became a guide to those who seized Jesus.

17 Because he had been numbered with us and obtained the lot of this service.

18 This man therefore indeed acquired a field from the wages of unrighteousness, and having become headlong, burst open in the middle, and all his inward parts were poured out.

19 And it became known to all those dwelling in Jerusalem, so that that field was called in their own dialect Akeldama, that is, Field of Blood.

20 For it is written in the book of Psalms, Let his dwelling become desolate, and let there be no one dwelling in it, and, Let another take his oversight.

21 It is necessary therefore, of the men who came together with us during all the time in which the Lord Jesus entered and went out among us,

22 having begun from John's baptism until the day on which he was taken up from us, that one of these become with us a witness of his resurrection.

23 And they put forward two, Joseph called Barsabas, who was surnamed Justus, and Matthias.

24 And having prayed, they said, You, Lord, knower of the hearts of all, show one of these two whom you chose,

25 to receive the lot of this service and apostleship, from which Judas turned aside to go to his own place.

26 And they gave their lots, and the lot fell upon Matthias, and he was counted together with the eleven apostles.

Chapter 2

1 And when the day of Pentecost was being fulfilled, they were all with one accord together.

2 And suddenly there came from heaven a sound as of a violent breath being borne along, and it filled the whole house where they were sitting.

3 And tongues dividing apart, as of fire, appeared to them, and it sat upon each one of them.

4 And all were filled with Holy Spirit and began to speak in other tongues, just as the Spirit was giving them to utter.

5 And there were Jews dwelling in Jerusalem, devout men from every nation under heaven.

6 And when this sound occurred, the multitude came together and was confounded, because each one was hearing them speaking in his own dialect.

7 And all were astonished and marveling, saying to each other, Look, are not all these who speak Galileans?

8 And how do we hear, each in our own dialect in which we were born?

9 Parthians and Medes and Elamites, and those dwelling in Mesopotamia, both Judea and Cappadocia, Pontus and Asia,

10 both Phrygia and Pamphylia, Egypt and the parts of Libya toward Cyrene, and visiting Romans, both Jews and proselytes,

11 Cretans and Arabs, we hear them speaking in our tongues the great things of God.

12 And all were astonished and greatly perplexed, saying one to another, What might this wish to be?

13 But others, mocking, were saying that they are filled with sweet wine.

14 But Peter, having stood with the eleven, raised his voice and uttered to them, Jewish men, and all those dwelling in Jerusalem, let this be known to you, and give ear to my sayings.

15 For these are not drunk as you suppose, for it is the third hour of the day.

16 But this is what was said through the prophet Joel:

17 And it will be in the last days, God says, I will pour out from my Spirit upon all flesh, and your sons and your daughters will prophesy, and your young men will see visions, and your elders will dream dreams.

18 And indeed upon my male slaves and upon my female slaves in those days I will pour out from my Spirit, and they will prophesy.

19 And I will give wonders in heaven above and signs upon the earth below, blood and fire and vapor of smoke.

20 The sun will be turned into darkness and the moon into blood before the great and manifest day of the Lord comes.

21 And it will be that everyone who calls upon the name of the Lord will be saved.

22 Israelite men, hear these words: Jesus the Nazarene, a man demonstrated to you by God with mighty works and wonders and signs which God did through him in your midst, just as you yourselves also know,

23 this man, delivered up by the determined counsel and foreknowledge of God, having taken, having fastened through the hands of lawless ones, you killed.

24 Whom God raised, having loosed the birth pains of death, because it was not possible for him to be held by it.

25 For David says concerning him, I was seeing the Lord before me continually, because he is at my right, so that I may not be shaken.

26 Because of this my heart was gladdened and my tongue exulted, and furthermore my flesh also will dwell in hope,

27 because you will not abandon my soul to Hades, nor give your holy one to see corruption.

28 You made known to me ways of life; you will fill me with gladness with your face.

29 Men, brothers, it is permitted to speak to you with openness concerning the patriarch David, that he both died and was buried, and his tomb is among us until this day.

30 Being therefore a prophet, and knowing that God swore to him with an oath to raise the Christ according to flesh from the fruit of his loins to sit upon his throne,

31 having seen beforehand, he spoke concerning the resurrection of the Christ, that his soul was not left to Hades, nor did his flesh see corruption.

32 This Jesus God raised, of whom we all are witnesses.

33 Having therefore been exalted by the right hand of God, and having received the promise of the Holy Spirit from the Father, he poured out this which you now see and hear.

34 For David did not ascend into the heavens, but he himself says, The Lord said to my Lord, Sit at my right,

35 until I place your enemies as a footstool of your feet.

36 Let all the house of Israel therefore know assuredly that God made him both Lord and Christ, this Jesus whom you crucified.

37 And having heard, they were pierced in the heart, and said to Peter and the remaining apostles, What shall we do, men, brothers?

38 And Peter said to them, Repent, and let each of you be baptized upon the name of Jesus Christ for forgiveness of sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.

39 For the promise is to you and to your children and to all those far away, as many as the Lord our God calls to himself.

40 And with many other words he was solemnly testifying and exhorting, saying, Be saved from this crooked generation.

41 Those therefore indeed who gladly received his word were baptized, and on that day about three thousand souls were added.

42 And they were persevering in the teaching of the apostles and in fellowship and in the breaking of bread and in prayers.

43 And fear came to every soul, and many wonders and signs were occurring through the apostles.

44 And all those believing were together and had all things common.

45 And they were selling their properties and possessions and dividing them to all, according as anyone had need.

46 And daily persevering with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread house by house, they were partaking of food in exultation and simplicity of heart,

47 praising God and having favor toward all the people. And the Lord was adding daily to the church those being saved.

Chapter 3

1 And Peter and John together were going up into the temple at the hour of prayer, the ninth.

2 And a certain man, being lame from his mother's womb, was being carried, whom they placed daily at the door of the temple called Beautiful, to ask alms from those entering into the temple.

3 Who, having seen Peter and John about to enter into the temple, was asking to receive alms.

4 And Peter, having looked intently at him with John, said, Look at us.

5 And he was attending to them, expecting to receive something from them.

6 But Peter said, Silver and gold do not belong to me, but what I have, this I give you. In the name of Jesus Christ the Nazarene, rise and walk.

7 And having seized him by the right hand, he raised him, and immediately his feet and ankles were strengthened.

8 And leaping up, he stood and was walking, and entered with them into the temple, walking and leaping and praising God.

9 And all the people saw him walking and praising God.

10 And they recognized him, that this was the one sitting for alms at the Beautiful Gate of the temple, and they were filled with amazement and astonishment at what had happened to him.

11 And as the healed lame man was holding Peter and John, all the people ran together to them at the portico called Solomon's, greatly amazed.

12 And Peter, having seen, answered the people, Israelite men, why do you marvel at this, or why do you look intently at us as though by our own power or piety we have made him walk?

13 The God of Abraham and Isaac and Jacob, the God of our fathers, glorified his servant Jesus, whom you handed over and denied before Pilate's face, when he had decided to release him.

14 But you denied the Holy and Righteous One, and asked that a man, a murderer, be granted to you.

15 And you killed the author of life, whom God raised from the dead, of whom we are witnesses.

16 And upon faith in his name, his name strengthened this man whom you behold and know, and the faith through him gave him this wholeness before all of you.

17 And now, brothers, I know that you acted according to ignorance, just as also your rulers.

18 But God thus fulfilled the things which he announced beforehand through the mouth of all his prophets, that the Christ should suffer.

19 Repent therefore and turn back, for your sins to be wiped away, so that seasons of refreshing may come from the face of the Lord,

20 and he may send Jesus Christ, who was proclaimed beforehand to you,

21 whom heaven indeed must receive until times of restoration of all things which God spoke through the mouth of all his holy prophets from the age.

22 For Moses indeed said to the fathers that the Lord your God will raise for you a prophet from your brothers as me; you shall hear him according to all things which he may speak to you.

23 And it will be that every soul who does not hear that prophet will be utterly destroyed from the people.

24 And all the prophets also from Samuel and those in succession, as many as spoke, also announced these days beforehand.

25 You are sons of the prophets and of the covenant which God covenanted with our fathers, saying to Abraham, And in your seed all the families of the earth will be blessed.

26 To you first God, having raised his servant Jesus, sent him blessing you in turning each from your wickednesses.

Chapter 4

1 And as they were speaking to the people, the priests and the captain of the temple and the Sadducees came upon them,

2 being greatly troubled because they teach the people and proclaim in Jesus the resurrection from the dead.

3 And they laid hands upon them and put them into custody until the next day, for it was already evening.

4 But many of those who heard the word believed, and the number of the men became about five thousand.

5 And it happened on the next day that their rulers and elders and scribes were gathered

6 in Jerusalem, and Annas the high priest and Caiaphas and John and Alexander, and as many as were from high-priestly kin.

7 And having stood them in the midst, they were inquiring, In what power or in what name did you do this?

8 Then Peter, having been filled with Holy Spirit, said to them, Rulers of the people and elders of Israel,

9 if we are examined today concerning a good deed to a sick person, by what this man has been saved,

10 let it be known to all of you and to all the people of Israel that in the name of Jesus Christ the Nazarene, whom you crucified, whom God raised from the dead, in him this man stands before you healthy.

11 This is the stone despised by you, the builders, which became the head of the corner.

12 And salvation is in no other, for neither is there another name under heaven given among people in which we must be saved.

13 And beholding the openness of Peter and John, and having perceived that they are unlettered people and ordinary men, they were marveling, and recognizing them, that they were with Jesus.

14 And seeing the man who had been healed standing with them, they had nothing to contradict.

15 And having commanded them to go outside the council, they conferred with each other,

16 saying, What shall we do to these people? For indeed that a known sign has occurred through them is manifest to all those dwelling in Jerusalem, and we cannot deny it.

17 But so that it may not spread further among the people, let us threaten them with a threat no longer to speak upon this name to any person.

18 And having called them, they commanded them not to utter at all nor teach upon the name of Jesus.

19 But Peter and John, answering them, said, Whether it is righteous before God to hear you rather than God, judge.

20 For we cannot but speak the things which we saw and heard.

21 And having threatened further, they released them, finding nothing as to how they might punish them because of the people, because all were glorifying God at what had happened.

22 For the man upon whom this sign of healing had occurred was more than forty years old.

23 And having been released, they came to their own and reported all that the chief priests and the elders said to them.

24 And having heard, they raised a voice to God with one accord and said, Master, you are God, who made heaven and earth and the sea and all things in them,

25 who through the mouth of David your servant said, Why did nations rage, and peoples ponder empty things?

26 The kings of the earth stood forth, and the rulers were gathered together against the Lord and against his Christ.

27 For in truth both Herod and Pontius Pilate were gathered against your holy servant Jesus, whom you anointed, with nations and peoples of Israel,

28 to do all things which your hand and your counsel determined beforehand to happen.

29 And now, Lord, look upon their threats, and give to your slaves to speak your word with all openness,

30 while you stretch out your hand for healing, and signs and wonders happen through the name of your holy servant Jesus.

31 And when they had pleaded, the place in which they were gathered was shaken, and all were filled with Holy Spirit and were speaking the word of God with openness.

32 And of the multitude of those who believed the heart and soul were one, and not even one was saying that anything of his possessions was his own, but all things were common to them.

33 And with great power the apostles were giving the testimony of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus, and great grace was upon them all.

34 For neither was there anyone needy among them, for as many as were possessors of fields or houses, selling, were bringing the prices of the things sold,

35 and placing them at the feet of the apostles, and it was distributed to each according as anyone had need.

36 And Joses, who was surnamed Barnabas by the apostles, which translated is Son of Exhortation, a Levite, a Cypriot by birth,

37 a field belonging to him, having sold it, brought the money and placed it at the feet of the apostles.

Chapter 5

1 And a certain man, Ananias by name, with Sapphira his wife, sold a property,

2 and kept back from the price, his wife also knowing, and having brought a certain part, placed it at the feet of the apostles.

3 But Peter said, Ananias, why did Satan fill your heart for you to lie to the Holy Spirit and keep back from the price of the field?

4 Remaining, did it not remain yours, and having been sold, was it not in your authority? Why did you put this deed in your heart? You did not lie to people, but to God.

5 And Ananias, hearing these words, having fallen, expired, and great fear came upon all those hearing these things.

6 And the younger men, having risen, wrapped him up, and having carried him out, buried him.

7 And an interval of about three hours passed, and his wife entered, not knowing what had happened.

8 And Peter answered her, Tell me whether you sold the field for so much. And she said, Yes, for so much.

9 But Peter said to her, Why was it agreed by you to test the Spirit of the Lord? Look, the feet of those who buried your husband are at the door, and they will carry you out.

10 And immediately she fell at his feet and expired. And the young men, having entered, found her dead, and having carried her out, buried her beside her husband.

11 And great fear came upon the whole church and upon all those hearing these things.

12 And through the hands of the apostles many signs and wonders were occurring among the people, and all were with one accord in Solomon's portico.

13 But none of the rest dared to join them, but the people were magnifying them.

14 And still more believers were being added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women,

15 so that they were carrying out the sick into the broad streets and placing them upon beds and pallets, so that as Peter came, even the shadow might overshadow some of them.

16 And the multitude from the surrounding cities also was coming together into Jerusalem, bringing sick people and those troubled by unclean spirits, who were all being healed.

17 But the high priest, having risen, and all those with him, being the sect of the Sadducees, were filled with jealousy,

18 and laid their hands upon the apostles and put them in public custody.

19 But an angel of the Lord through the night opened the doors of the prison, and having led them out, said,

20 Go, and having stood, speak in the temple to the people all the sayings of this life.

21 And having heard, they entered into the temple toward dawn and were teaching. But the high priest and those with him, having come, called together the council and all the eldership of the sons of Israel, and sent to the prison for them to be brought.

22 But the officers, having come, did not find them in the prison, and having returned, reported,

23 saying, We indeed found the prison shut in all security, and the guards standing outside before the doors, but having opened, we found no one inside.

24 And when both the priest and the captain of the temple and the chief priests heard these words, they were greatly perplexed concerning them, what this might become.

25 And someone, having come, reported to them, saying, Look, the men whom you put in the prison are standing in the temple and teaching the people.

26 Then the captain, having gone away with the officers, brought them, not with violence, for they feared the people, lest they be stoned.

27 And having brought them, they stood them in the council, and the high priest asked them,

28 saying, Did we not command you with a command not to teach upon this name? And look, you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching, and wish to bring upon us the blood of this man.

29 But Peter and the apostles, answering, said, It is necessary to obey God rather than people.

30 The God of our fathers raised Jesus, whom you killed, having hung him upon wood.

31 This one God exalted by his right hand as leader and Savior, to give repentance to Israel and forgiveness of sins.

32 And we are his witnesses of these sayings, and also the Holy Spirit, whom God gave to those obeying him.

33 But having heard, they were being cut through, and were taking counsel to kill them.

34 But a certain Pharisee in the council, Gamaliel by name, a teacher of law honored by all the people, having risen, commanded that the apostles be put outside for a little while.

35 And he said to them, Israelite men, pay attention to yourselves concerning these people, what you are about to do.

36 For before these days Theudas rose, saying that he himself was someone, to whom a number of about four hundred men joined themselves, who was killed, and all who were obeying him were dissolved and came to nothing.

37 After this man Judas the Galilean rose in the days of the registration and drew away a considerable people after him; and he perished, and all who were obeying him were scattered.

38 And now I say to you, Stand away from these people and allow them, because if this counsel or this work is from people, it will be destroyed.

39 But if it is from God, you cannot destroy it, lest you even be found fighting against God.

40 And they were persuaded by him, and having called the apostles, having beaten them, commanded them not to speak upon the name of Jesus, and released them.

41 They therefore indeed were going rejoicing from the face of the council, because they were counted worthy to be dishonored for his name.

42 And every day in the temple and house by house, they were not ceasing to teach and proclaim Jesus the Christ as good news.

Chapter 6

1 And in these days, as the disciples were multiplying, there arose a murmuring of the Hellenists against the Hebrews, because their widows were being overlooked in the daily service.

2 And the twelve, having summoned the multitude of the disciples, said, It is not pleasing for us, having left the word of God, to serve tables.

3 Look out therefore, brothers, seven men from you, well attested, full of Holy Spirit and wisdom, whom we will appoint over this need.

4 But we will persevere in prayer and in the service of the word.

5 And the word pleased the whole multitude, and they chose Stephen, a man full of faith and Holy Spirit, and Philip and Prochorus and Nicanor and Timon and Parmenas and Nicolaus, an Antiochene proselyte,

6 whom they stood before the apostles, and having prayed, laid hands upon them.

7 And the word of God was increasing, and the number of the disciples was multiplying greatly in Jerusalem, and a great crowd of the priests were obeying the faith.

8 And Stephen, full of faith and power, was doing great wonders and signs among the people.

9 But some of those from the synagogue called of the Freedmen, and of Cyrenians and Alexandrians and those from Cilicia and Asia, rose, disputing with Stephen.

10 And they were not strong enough to resist the wisdom and the Spirit by which he was speaking.

11 Then they instigated men saying, We have heard him speaking blasphemous sayings against Moses and God.

12 And they stirred up the people and the elders and the scribes, and having come upon him, seized him and brought him into the council.

13 And they set up false witnesses saying, This man does not cease speaking blasphemous sayings against this holy place and the law.

14 For we have heard him saying that this Jesus the Nazarene will destroy this place and change the customs which Moses handed over to us.

15 And all those sitting in the council, having looked intently at him, saw his face as a face of an angel.

Chapter 7

1 And the high priest said, Are these things then thus?

2 And he said, Men, brothers and fathers, hear. The God of glory appeared to our father Abraham while he was in Mesopotamia, before he dwelt in Haran,

3 and said to him, Go out from your land and from your kin, and come into a land which I will show you.

4 Then having gone out from the land of Chaldeans, he dwelt in Haran, and from there, after his father died, he moved him into this land in which you now dwell.

5 And he gave him no inheritance in it, not even a foot's step, and promised to give it to him for possession and to his seed after him, when he had no child.

6 And God spoke thus, that his seed will be a sojourner in a foreign land, and they will enslave it and mistreat it four hundred years.

7 And the nation which they serve I will judge, God said, and after these things they will go out and worship me in this place.

8 And he gave him a covenant of circumcision, and thus he begot Isaac and circumcised him on the eighth day, and Isaac Jacob, and Jacob the twelve patriarchs.

9 And the patriarchs, having become jealous of Joseph, sold him into Egypt, and God was with him,

10 and delivered him from all his afflictions, and gave him favor and wisdom before Pharaoh king of Egypt, and appointed him ruler over Egypt and all his house.

11 And famine came upon all the land of Egypt and Canaan, and great affliction, and our fathers were finding no provisions.

12 But Jacob, having heard that there was grain in Egypt, sent out our fathers first.

13 And on the second occasion Joseph was recognized by his brothers, and Joseph's family became manifest to Pharaoh.

14 And Joseph, having sent, called for his father Jacob and all his kin, seventy-five souls.

15 And Jacob went down into Egypt and died, he and our fathers.

16 And they were transferred to Shechem and placed in the tomb which Abraham bought for a price of silver from the sons of Emmor, Emor of Shechem.

17 And just as the time of the promise which God swore to Abraham was drawing near, the people increased and multiplied in Egypt,

18 until another king rose who did not know Joseph.

19 This man, having dealt craftily with our race, mistreated our fathers, making their infants exposed so that they might not be preserved alive.

20 At which time Moses was born, and was beautiful to God, who was reared three months in his father's house.

21 And when he was exposed, Pharaoh's daughter took him up and reared him for herself as a son.

22 And Moses was educated in all wisdom of Egyptians, and was mighty in words and in works.

23 And when a forty-year time was being fulfilled for him, it came upon his heart to visit his brothers, the sons of Israel.

24 And having seen someone being wronged, he defended him and made vengeance for the one being oppressed, having struck the Egyptian.

25 And he was supposing his brothers understood that God through his hand gives them salvation, but they did not understand.

26 And on the following day he appeared to them fighting, and was driving them together into peace, saying, Men, you are brothers. Why do you wrong each other?

27 But the one wronging his neighbor pushed him away, saying, Who appointed you ruler and judge over us?

28 You do not wish to kill me in the manner you killed the Egyptian yesterday, do you?

29 And Moses fled at this word, and became a sojourner in the land of Midian, where he begot two sons.

30 And forty years having been fulfilled, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in the wilderness of Mount Sinai, in a flame of fire of a bush.

31 And Moses, having seen, marveled at the vision, and as he was approaching to observe, a voice of the Lord came to him,

32 I am the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham and the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob. And Moses, having become trembling, did not dare to observe.

33 And the Lord said to him, Untie the sandal of your feet, for the place in which you stand is holy ground.

34 Having seen, I saw the mistreatment of my people in Egypt, and heard their groaning, and descended to deliver them. And now come, I will send you into Egypt.

35 This Moses whom they denied, saying, Who appointed you ruler and judge? this man God sent as ruler and redeemer by the hand of the angel who appeared to him in the bush.

36 This man led them out, having done wonders and signs in the land of Egypt and in the Red Sea and in the wilderness forty years.

37 This is the Moses who said to the sons of Israel, The Lord your God will raise for you a prophet from your brothers as me; you shall hear him.

38 This is the one who was in the assembly in the wilderness with the angel speaking to him on Mount Sinai and our fathers, who received living oracles to give us,

39 to whom our fathers did not wish to become obedient, but pushed him away, and turned in their hearts into Egypt,

40 saying to Aaron, Make us gods who will go before us, for this Moses, who led us out from the land of Egypt, we do not know what has happened to him.

41 And they made a calf in those days, and brought up a sacrifice to the idol, and were rejoicing in the works of their hands.

42 But God turned and handed them over to worship the host of heaven, just as it is written in the book of the prophets, You did not offer me slaughtered animals and sacrifices forty years in the wilderness, house of Israel, did you?

43 And you took up the tent of Moloch and the star of your god Remphan, the forms which you made to worship them, and I will relocate you beyond Babylon.

44 The tent of testimony was among our fathers in the wilderness, just as the one speaking to Moses commanded to make it according to the pattern which he had seen.

45 Which our fathers also, having received in succession, brought in with Joshua in the possession of the nations whom God drove out from the face of our fathers, until the days of David,

46 who found favor before God and asked to find a dwelling for the God of Jacob.

47 But Solomon built him a house.

48 But the Most High does not dwell in sanctuaries made by hands, just as the prophet says,

49 Heaven is my throne, and the earth a footstool of my feet. What kind of house will you build me, the Lord says, or what is the place of my rest?

50 Did not my hand make all these things?

51 Stiff-necked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Spirit; as your fathers, also you.

52 Which of the prophets did your fathers not persecute? And they killed those announcing beforehand concerning the coming of the Righteous One, of whom you have now become betrayers and murderers,

53 you who received the law as ordinances of angels and did not keep it.

54 And hearing these things, they were being cut through in their hearts, and were grinding their teeth against him.

55 But being full of Holy Spirit, having looked intently into heaven, he saw glory of God, and Jesus standing at the right of God,

56 and said, Look, I behold the heavens opened, and the Son of Man standing at the right of God.

57 But having cried out with a loud voice, they closed their ears and rushed upon him with one accord.

58 And having cast him outside the city, they were stoning him, and the witnesses put off their garments at the feet of a young man called Saul.

59 And they were stoning Stephen, calling upon and saying, Lord Jesus, receive my spirit.

60 And having placed his knees down, he cried out with a loud voice, Lord, do not set this sin against them. And having said this, he fell asleep.

Chapter 8

1 And Saul was consenting to his killing. And on that day a great persecution arose against the church in Jerusalem, and all were scattered throughout the regions of Judea and Samaria except the apostles.

2 And devout men carried Stephen to burial and made a great lamentation over him.

3 But Saul was ravaging the church, entering house by house, and dragging men and women, was handing them over into prison.

4 Those therefore indeed who were scattered went through, proclaiming the word as good news.

5 And Philip, having gone down into a city of Samaria, was proclaiming the Christ to them.

6 And the crowds with one accord were attending to the things said by Philip, as they heard and saw the signs which he was doing.

7 For from many of those having unclean spirits they were coming out, crying with a loud voice, and many paralyzed and lame were healed.

8 And great joy came in that city.

9 But a certain man named Simon was previously in the city practicing magic and astonishing the nation of Samaria, saying that he himself was someone great,

10 to whom all were attending, from small to great, saying, This man is the great power of God.

11 And they were attending to him because for a considerable time he had astonished them with the magic arts.

12 But when they believed Philip proclaiming the things concerning the kingdom of God and the name of Jesus Christ as good news, both men and women were being baptized.

13 And Simon himself also believed, and having been baptized, was persevering with Philip, and beholding signs and great mighty works occurring, was astonished.

14 And the apostles in Jerusalem, having heard that Samaria has received the word of God, sent Peter and John to them,

15 who, having gone down, prayed concerning them, so that they might receive Holy Spirit.

16 For he had not yet fallen upon any of them, but they had only been baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus.

17 Then they were laying hands upon them, and they were receiving Holy Spirit.

18 And Simon, having beheld that the Holy Spirit is given through the laying on of the apostles' hands, offered them money,

19 saying, Give me also this authority, so that whomever I lay hands upon may receive Holy Spirit.

20 But Peter said to him, May your silver with you be for destruction, because you supposed the gift of God to be acquired through money.

21 You have no part nor lot in this matter, for your heart is not straight before God.

22 Repent therefore from this wickedness of yours, and plead with God whether perhaps the intent of your heart will be forgiven you.

23 For I see you being in gall of bitterness and a bond of unrighteousness.

24 But Simon, answering, said, You plead for me to the Lord, so that nothing of what you have said may come upon me.

25 They therefore indeed, having solemnly testified and spoken the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem, and proclaimed good news to many villages of the Samaritans.

26 And an angel of the Lord spoke to Philip, saying, Rise and go toward the south upon the road descending from Jerusalem into Gaza. This is deserted.

27 And having risen, he went. And look, an Ethiopian man, a eunuch, an official of Candace the queen of Ethiopians, who was over all her treasury, who had come to Jerusalem to worship,

28 and was returning, and sitting upon his chariot, and was reading the prophet Isaiah.

29 And the Spirit said to Philip, Approach and join yourself to this chariot.

30 And Philip, having run up, heard him reading the prophet Isaiah and said, Do you indeed know what you read?

31 And he said, For how could I, unless someone guides me? And he invited Philip to come up and sit with him.

32 And the passage of the Scripture which he was reading was this: As a sheep he was led to slaughter, and as a lamb voiceless before the one shearing it, thus he does not open his mouth.

33 In his humiliation his judgment was taken away, and who will recount his generation? Because his life is taken away from the earth.

34 And the eunuch, answering Philip, said, I plead with you, concerning whom does the prophet say this, concerning himself or concerning someone else?

35 And Philip, having opened his mouth and having begun from this Scripture, proclaimed Jesus to him as good news.

36 And as they were going along the road, they came upon some water, and the eunuch says, Look, water. What hinders me from being baptized?

37 And Philip said, If you believe from the whole heart, it is lawful. And answering, he said, I believe Jesus Christ to be the Son of God.

38 And he commanded the chariot to stand, and both went down into the water, both Philip and the eunuch, and he baptized him.

39 And when they came up from the water, the Spirit of the Lord snatched Philip away, and the eunuch saw him no longer, for he was going his way rejoicing.

40 But Philip was found at Azotus, and passing through, was proclaiming good news to all the cities until he came to Caesarea.

Chapter 9

1 But Saul, still breathing threat and murder against the disciples of the Lord, having approached the high priest,

2 asked from him letters to Damascus, to the synagogues, so that if he found any being of the Way, both men and women, he might bring them bound into Jerusalem.

3 And as he was going, it happened that he drew near to Damascus, and suddenly a light from heaven flashed around him.

4 And having fallen upon the earth, he heard a voice saying to him, Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?

5 And he said, Who are you, Lord? And the Lord said, I am Jesus whom you persecute. It is hard for you to kick against goads.

6 And trembling and astonished, he said, Lord, what do you wish me to do? And the Lord said to him, Rise and enter into the city, and it will be spoken to you what you must do.

7 And the men journeying with him stood speechless, hearing indeed the voice, but beholding no one.

8 And Saul was raised from the earth, and though his eyes were opened, he was seeing no one; and leading him by hand, they brought him into Damascus.

9 And he was three days not seeing, and did not eat nor drink.

10 And there was a certain disciple in Damascus named Ananias, and the Lord said to him in a vision, Ananias. And he said, Look, I am here, Lord.

11 And the Lord said to him, Rise and go to the street called Straight, and seek in the house of Judas a man named Saul, a Tarsian, for look, he prays,

12 and saw in a vision a man named Ananias entering and laying a hand upon him, so that he might receive sight.

13 But Ananias answered, Lord, I have heard from many concerning this man, how many evil things he did to your saints in Jerusalem.

14 And here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all those calling upon your name.

15 But the Lord said to him, Go, because this man is to me a vessel of election, to carry my name before nations and kings and sons of Israel.

16 For I will show him how many things he must suffer for my name.

17 And Ananias went away and entered into the house, and having laid hands upon him, said, Saul, brother, the Lord has sent me, Jesus, who appeared to you on the road by which you were coming, so that you may receive sight and be filled with Holy Spirit.

18 And immediately there fell away from his eyes as scales, and he received sight at once, and having risen, was baptized.

19 And having received food, he was strengthened. And Saul was with the disciples in Damascus some days.

20 And immediately in the synagogues he was proclaiming the Christ, that this is the Son of God.

21 And all those hearing were astonished, and were saying, Is this not the one who devastated in Jerusalem those calling upon this name, and had come here for this, so that he might bring them bound before the chief priests?

22 But Saul was being empowered more, and was confounding the Jews dwelling in Damascus, proving that this is the Christ.

23 And when considerable days were being fulfilled, the Jews took counsel together to kill him.

24 But their plot became known to Saul, and they were watching the gates both day and night, so that they might kill him.

25 But the disciples, having taken him by night, let him down through the wall, having lowered him in a basket.

26 And Saul, having come to Jerusalem, was trying to join himself to the disciples, and all were fearing him, not believing that he is a disciple.

27 But Barnabas, having taken hold of him, brought him to the apostles, and recounted to them how on the road he saw the Lord, and that he spoke to him, and how in Damascus he spoke openly in the name of Jesus.

28 And he was with them, entering and going out in Jerusalem,

29 and speaking openly in the name of the Lord Jesus, and was speaking and disputing with the Hellenists, but they were attempting to kill him.

30 And the brothers, having learned it, brought him down to Caesarea and sent him out to Tarsus.

31 The churches therefore indeed throughout all Judea and Galilee and Samaria had peace, being built up and walking in the fear of the Lord, and were multiplying in the encouragement of the Holy Spirit.

32 And it happened that Peter, passing through all, went down also to the saints dwelling in Lydda.

33 And there he found a certain person named Aeneas, lying upon a pallet for eight years, who was paralyzed.

34 And Peter said to him, Aeneas, Jesus the Christ heals you. Rise and spread a bed for yourself. And immediately he rose.

35 And all those dwelling in Lydda and Sharon saw him, who turned to the Lord.

36 And in Joppa there was a certain female disciple named Tabitha, which interpreted is said Dorcas. She was full of good works and alms which she was doing.

37 And it happened in those days that she became sick and died, and having washed her, they placed her in an upper room.

38 And Lydda being near Joppa, the disciples, having heard that Peter is in it, sent two men to him, exhorting him not to delay to come through as far as them.

39 And Peter, having risen, went with them, whom, having come, they brought up into the upper room. And all the widows stood by him, weeping and showing tunics and garments, as many as Dorcas was making while being with them.

40 But Peter, having cast all outside, having placed his knees down, prayed, and having turned to the body, said, Tabitha, rise. And she opened her eyes, and having seen Peter, sat up.

41 And having given her a hand, he raised her, and having called the saints and the widows, presented her alive.

42 And it became known throughout all Joppa, and many believed upon the Lord.

43 And it happened that he remained considerable days in Joppa with a certain Simon, a tanner.

Chapter 10

1 And there was a certain man in Caesarea named Cornelius, a centurion from the cohort called Italian,

2 pious and fearing God with all his house, and doing many alms for the people and pleading with God continually.

3 He saw clearly in a vision, about the ninth hour of the day, an angel of God entering to him and saying to him, Cornelius.

4 And he, having looked intently at him and having become fearful, said, What is it, Lord? And he said to him, Your prayers and your alms ascended as a memorial before God.

5 And now send men to Joppa, and summon Simon, who is surnamed Peter.

6 This man lodges with a certain Simon, a tanner, whose house is by the sea. He will speak to you what you must do.

7 And when the angel speaking to Cornelius went away, having called two of his household servants and a pious soldier of those attending him,

8 and having explained all things to them, he sent them to Joppa.

9 And on the next day, while they were journeying and drawing near the city, Peter went up upon the housetop to pray about the sixth hour.

10 And he became hungry and wished to taste food, but while they were preparing, a trance fell upon him.

11 And he beholds heaven opened, and a certain vessel descending upon him, as a great sheet bound at four corners and being lowered upon the earth,

12 in which were all the four-footed creatures of the earth, and the wild beasts and the creeping things and the birds of heaven.

13 And a voice came to him, Rise, Peter, slaughter and eat.

14 But Peter said, By no means, Lord, because I never ate anything common or unclean.

15 And a voice again a second time came to him, What God cleansed, do not make common.

16 And this happened three times, and again the vessel was taken up into heaven.

17 And as Peter was greatly perplexed within himself as to what the vision which he saw might be, look, the men sent from Cornelius, having inquired for Simon's house, stood at the gateway,

18 and having called, were inquiring whether Simon surnamed Peter lodges here.

19 And while Peter was considering the vision, the Spirit said to him, Look, three men seek you.

20 But rise, go down and go with them, doubting nothing, because I have sent them.

21 And Peter, having gone down to the men sent from Cornelius to him, said, Look, I am the one whom you seek. What is the reason because of which you are present?

22 And they said, Cornelius, a centurion, a righteous man and fearing God, and attested by the whole nation of the Jews, was divinely instructed by a holy angel to summon you into his house and hear sayings from you.

23 Having therefore called them in, he lodged them. And on the next day Peter went out with them, and some of the brothers from Joppa went with him.

24 And on the next day they entered into Caesarea, and Cornelius was expecting them, having called together his relatives and close friends.

25 And when Peter came to enter, Cornelius, having met him, having fallen at his feet, worshiped.

26 But Peter raised him, saying, Rise; I myself also am a person.

27 And conversing with him, he entered, and finds many gathered.

28 And he said to them, You know how it is unlawful for a Jewish man to join or approach a foreigner, and God showed me to call no person common or unclean.

29 Because of this also I came without objection when summoned. I inquire therefore, For what reason did you summon me?

30 And Cornelius said, From the fourth day until this hour I was fasting, and at the ninth hour praying in my house, and look, a man stood before me in splendid clothing,

31 and says, Cornelius, your prayer was heard, and your alms were remembered before God.

32 Send therefore to Joppa, and call for Simon, who is surnamed Peter. He lodges in the house of Simon a tanner by the sea, who, having come, will speak to you.

33 Immediately therefore I sent to you, and you did well having come. Now therefore we all are present before God to hear all things commanded you by God.

34 And Peter, having opened his mouth, said, In truth I perceive that God is not a respecter of persons,

35 but in every nation the one fearing him and working righteousness is acceptable to him.

36 The word which he sent to the sons of Israel, proclaiming peace as good news through Jesus Christ, he is Lord of all,

37 you know the saying that occurred throughout all Judea, having begun from Galilee after the baptism which John proclaimed:

38 Jesus from Nazareth, how God anointed him with Holy Spirit and power, who went through doing good and healing all those oppressed by the devil, because God was with him.

39 And we are witnesses of all things which he did both in the country of the Jews and in Jerusalem, whom they killed, having hung him upon wood.

40 This one God raised on the third day and gave him to become manifest,

41 not to all the people, but to witnesses appointed beforehand by God, to us who ate together and drank together with him after he rose from the dead.

42 And he commanded us to proclaim to the people and testify solemnly that he is the one determined by God as judge of living and dead.

43 To him all the prophets testify, that everyone believing in him receives forgiveness of sins through his name.

44 While Peter was still speaking these sayings, the Holy Spirit fell upon all those hearing the word.

45 And the believers from circumcision, as many as came with Peter, were astonished, because upon the nations also the gift of the Holy Spirit has been poured out.

46 For they were hearing them speaking in tongues and magnifying God. Then Peter answered,

47 Can anyone forbid the water so that these may not be baptized, who received the Holy Spirit just as we also?

48 And he commanded them to be baptized in the name of the Lord. Then they asked him to remain some days.

Chapter 11

1 And the apostles and the brothers who were throughout Judea heard that the nations also received the word of God.

2 And when Peter went up to Jerusalem, those from circumcision were disputing with him,

3 saying, You entered to men having uncircumcision and ate with them.

4 But Peter, having begun, was setting it out to them in succession, saying,

5 I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision, a certain vessel descending as a great sheet, being lowered by four corners from heaven, and it came as far as me.

6 Into which, having looked intently, I was observing, and saw the four-footed creatures of the earth and the wild beasts and the creeping things and the birds of heaven.

7 And I heard a voice saying to me, Rise, Peter, slaughter and eat.

8 But I said, By no means, Lord, because anything common or unclean never entered into my mouth.

9 And a voice answered me a second time from heaven, What God cleansed, do not make common.

10 And this happened three times, and all things were drawn up again into heaven.

11 And look, immediately three men stood at the house in which I was, sent from Caesarea to me.

12 And the Spirit said to me to go with them, doubting nothing. And these six brothers also came with me, and we entered into the man's house.

13 And he reported to us how he saw the angel standing in his house and saying to him, Send men to Joppa and summon Simon surnamed Peter,

14 who will speak sayings to you in which you and all your house will be saved.

15 And as I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell upon them, just as also upon us in the beginning.

16 And I remembered the saying of the Lord, how he was saying, John indeed baptized with water, but you will be baptized in Holy Spirit.

17 If therefore God gave them the equal gift as also to us who believed upon the Lord Jesus Christ, but who was I, able to hinder God?

18 And having heard these things, they became quiet and were glorifying God, saying, Then indeed God gave to the nations also repentance into life.

19 Those therefore indeed scattered from the affliction that arose over Stephen went through as far as Phoenicia and Cyprus and Antioch, speaking the word to no one except Jews only.

20 But some of them were Cypriot and Cyrenian men, who, having entered into Antioch, were speaking to the Hellenists, proclaiming the Lord Jesus as good news.

21 And the hand of the Lord was with them, and a great number, having believed, turned to the Lord.

22 And the account concerning them was heard in the ears of the church in Jerusalem, and they sent out Barnabas to go through as far as Antioch,

23 who, having come and having seen the grace of God, rejoiced, and was exhorting all to remain with the Lord with purpose of heart.

24 Because he was a good man and full of Holy Spirit and faith, and a considerable crowd was added to the Lord.

25 And Barnabas went out to Tarsus to seek out Saul,

26 and having found him, brought him to Antioch. And it happened that they gathered in the church a whole year and taught a considerable crowd, and that the disciples were first called Christians in Antioch.

27 And in these days prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch.

28 And one of them, Agabus by name, having risen, signified through the Spirit that a great famine was about to be upon all the inhabited world, which also happened under Claudius Caesar.

29 And the disciples, according as anyone had means, determined, each of them, to send for service to the brothers dwelling in Judea,

30 which they also did, having sent to the elders through the hand of Barnabas and Saul.

Chapter 12

1 And at that season Herod the king laid hands on some from the church to mistreat them.

2 And he killed James, the brother of John, with a sword.

3 And having seen that it is pleasing to the Jews, he proceeded to seize Peter also. And they were days of Unleavened Bread.

4 Whom, having also seized, he put into prison, having handed him over to four squads of four soldiers to guard him, wishing after the Passover to bring him up to the people.

5 Peter therefore indeed was being kept in the prison, but earnest prayer was being made by the church to God for him.

6 And when Herod was about to bring him forward, on that night Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains, and guards before the door were keeping the prison.

7 And look, an angel of the Lord stood by, and light shone in the dwelling, and having struck Peter's side, raised him, saying, Rise quickly. And his chains fell off from his hands.

8 And the angel said to him, Gird yourself and bind on your sandals. And he did thus. And he says to him, Put on your garment and follow me.

9 And having gone out, he was following him, and did not know that what was happening through the angel is true, but was supposing he sees a vision.

10 And having passed through a first guard and a second, they came to the iron gate leading into the city, which opened of itself to them, and having gone out, they went along one street, and immediately the angel departed from him.

11 And Peter, having come to himself, said, Now I truly know that the Lord sent out his angel and delivered me from Herod's hand and all the expectation of the people of the Jews.

12 And having considered, he came to the house of Mary, the mother of John surnamed Mark, where considerable numbers were gathered and praying.

13 And when Peter knocked at the door of the gateway, a servant girl named Rhoda approached to answer.

14 And having recognized Peter's voice, from joy she did not open the gateway, but having run in, reported that Peter stands before the gateway.

15 But they said to her, You are mad. But she was insisting that it is thus. And they were saying, It is his angel.

16 But Peter was persisting in knocking, and having opened, they saw him and were astonished.

17 And having motioned to them with the hand to be silent, he recounted to them how the Lord led him out of the prison, and said, Report these things to James and the brothers. And having gone out, he went into another place.

18 And when day came, there was no little disturbance among the soldiers as to what then Peter had become.

19 And Herod, having sought him and not having found, having examined the guards, commanded them to be led away. And having gone down from Judea to Caesarea, he was spending time there.

20 And Herod was fighting angrily with Tyrians and Sidonians, but they came to him with one accord, and having persuaded Blastus, the one over the king's bedchamber, were asking peace, because their country was fed from the royal country.

21 And on an appointed day Herod, having clothed himself in royal clothing and having sat upon the judgment seat, was addressing them publicly.

22 And the populace was shouting, A god's voice, and not a person's.

23 And immediately an angel of the Lord struck him, because he did not give the glory to God, and having become eaten by worms, he expired.

24 But the word of God was increasing and multiplying.

25 And Barnabas and Saul returned from Jerusalem, having fulfilled the service, having also taken along John surnamed Mark.

Chapter 13

1 And there were some prophets and teachers in Antioch, in the church there, both Barnabas and Simeon called Niger and Lucius the Cyrenian, and Manaen, a foster companion of Herod the tetrarch, and Saul.

2 And as they were ministering to the Lord and fasting, the Holy Spirit said, Separate for me now both Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them.

3 Then having fasted and prayed and laid hands upon them, they released them.

4 These therefore indeed, having been sent out by the Holy Spirit, went down to Seleucia, and from there sailed away to Cyprus.

5 And having come to Salamis, they were proclaiming the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews, and had John also as an attendant.

6 And having passed through the island as far as Paphos, they found a certain magician, a false prophet, a Jew whose name was Bar-Jesus,

7 who was with the proconsul Sergius Paulus, an understanding man. This man, having summoned Barnabas and Saul, sought to hear the word of God.

8 But Elymas the magician, for thus his name is translated, was resisting them, seeking to turn the proconsul away from the faith.

9 But Saul, who is also Paul, having been filled with Holy Spirit and having looked intently at him,

10 said, O full of all deceit and all villainy, son of the devil, enemy of all righteousness, will you not cease perverting the straight ways of the Lord?

11 And now look, the hand of the Lord is upon you, and you will be blind, not seeing the sun until a season. And immediately mist and darkness fell upon him, and going around, he was seeking people to lead him by hand.

12 Then the proconsul, having seen what happened, believed, being astounded at the teaching of the Lord.

13 And those around Paul, having put out from Paphos, came to Perga of Pamphylia, but John, having departed from them, returned to Jerusalem.

14 But they, having passed through from Perga, came to Antioch of Pisidia, and having entered into the synagogue on the Sabbath day, sat down.

15 And after the reading of the law and the prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent to them, saying, Men, brothers, if there is in you a word of exhortation to the people, speak.

16 And Paul, having risen and having motioned with the hand, said, Israelite men and those fearing God, hear.

17 The God of this people Israel chose our fathers, and exalted the people in the sojourn in the land of Egypt, and with an uplifted arm led them out from it.

18 And for about a forty-year time he bore their conduct in the wilderness.

19 And having overthrown seven nations in the land of Canaan, he gave their land to them as an inheritance.

20 And after these things, for about four hundred fifty years, he gave judges until Samuel the prophet.

21 And from then they asked for a king, and God gave them Saul, son of Kish, a man from the tribe of Benjamin, forty years.

22 And having removed him, he raised David for them as king, to whom also, having testified, he said, I found David of Jesse, a man according to my heart, who will do all my wills.

23 From this man's seed God, according to promise, raised for Israel a Savior, Jesus,

24 John having proclaimed beforehand, before the face of his entrance, a baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel.

25 And as John was fulfilling the course, he was saying, Whom do you suppose me to be? I am not he. But look, there comes after me one whose sandal of the feet I am not worthy to untie.

26 Men, brothers, sons of the race of Abraham, and those among you fearing God, to you the word of this salvation was sent.

27 For those dwelling in Jerusalem and their rulers, having not known this one and the voices of the prophets read every Sabbath, having judged him, fulfilled them.

28 And having found no cause of death, they asked Pilate that he be killed.

29 And when they completed all things written concerning him, having taken him down from the wood, they placed him into a tomb.

30 But God raised him from the dead,

31 who appeared for many days to those who came up with him from Galilee into Jerusalem, who are his witnesses to the people.

32 And we proclaim to you as good news the promise made to the fathers,

33 that God has fulfilled this to their children, to us, having raised Jesus, as it is also written in the second Psalm, You are my Son; I today have begotten you.

34 And that he raised him from the dead, no longer about to return into corruption, he has spoken thus, I will give you the holy things of David, the faithful things.

35 Because of this also in another he says, You will not give your holy one to see corruption.

36 For David indeed, having served his own generation by the counsel of God, fell asleep and was added to his fathers, and saw corruption.

37 But the one whom God raised did not see corruption.

38 Let it therefore be known to you, men, brothers, that through this one forgiveness of sins is proclaimed to you,

39 and from all things from which you could not be justified in the law of Moses, in this one everyone believing is justified.

40 See therefore that what was said in the prophets does not come upon you:

41 See, despisers, and marvel and vanish, because I work a work in your days, a work which you will certainly not believe if anyone recounts it to you.

42 And as they were going out from the synagogue of the Jews, the nations were asking that these sayings be spoken to them on the intervening Sabbath.

43 And when the synagogue was dismissed, many of the Jews and the worshiping proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas, who, speaking to them, were persuading them to remain in the grace of God.

44 And on the coming Sabbath almost all the city was gathered to hear the word of God.

45 But the Jews, having seen the crowds, were filled with jealousy, and were contradicting the things said by Paul, contradicting and blaspheming.

46 And Paul and Barnabas, having spoken openly, said, It was necessary that the word of God be spoken first to you, but since you push it away and judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life, look, we turn to the nations.

47 For thus the Lord has commanded us, I have placed you as a light of nations, for you to be for salvation as far as the end of the earth.

48 And the nations, hearing, were rejoicing and glorifying the word of the Lord, and as many as had been appointed to eternal life believed.

49 And the word of the Lord was being carried through the whole country.

50 But the Jews incited the worshiping women and the prominent women and the foremost of the city, and stirred up persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and cast them out from their borders.

51 But they, having shaken off the dust of their feet against them, came to Iconium.

52 And the disciples were being filled with joy and Holy Spirit.

Chapter 14

1 And it happened in Iconium that they entered together into the synagogue of the Jews and spoke thus, so that a great multitude both of Jews and Greeks believed.

2 But the disobeying Jews stirred up and embittered the souls of the nations against the brothers.

3 They therefore indeed spent considerable time speaking openly upon the Lord, who was testifying to the word of his grace and giving signs and wonders to occur through their hands.

4 But the multitude of the city was divided, and some were with the Jews, but others with the apostles.

5 And when a rush arose of both nations and Jews with their rulers to abuse and stone them,

6 having perceived it, they fled to the cities of Lycaonia, Lystra and Derbe, and the surrounding region,

7 and there were proclaiming good news.

8 And a certain man in Lystra, powerless in the feet, was sitting, being lame from his mother's womb, who had never walked.

9 This man was hearing Paul speaking, who, having looked intently at him and having seen that he has faith to be saved,

10 said with a loud voice, Rise upright upon your feet. And he was leaping and walking.

11 And the crowds, having seen what Paul did, raised their voice, saying in Lycaonian, The gods, having become like people, came down to us.

12 And they were calling Barnabas Zeus, but Paul Hermes, since he was the one leading the speech.

13 And the priest of Zeus who was before their city, having brought bulls and garlands to the gateways, wished to sacrifice with the crowds.

14 But the apostles Barnabas and Paul, having heard, having torn their garments, leaped into the crowd, crying out,

15 and saying, Men, why do you do these things? We also are people of like passions with you, proclaiming good news to you to turn from these vain things to the living God, who made heaven and earth and the sea and all things in them,

16 who in the generations gone by allowed all the nations to go in their ways.

17 And yet indeed he did not leave himself without witness, doing good, giving us rains from heaven and fruit-bearing seasons, filling our hearts with food and gladness.

18 And saying these things, they scarcely restrained the crowds from sacrificing to them.

19 But Jews came from Antioch and Iconium, and having persuaded the crowds and having stoned Paul, they were dragging him outside the city, supposing him to have died.

20 But when the disciples encircled him, having risen, he entered into the city, and on the next day went out with Barnabas to Derbe.

21 And having proclaimed good news to that city and made considerable disciples, they returned to Lystra and Iconium and Antioch,

22 strengthening the souls of the disciples, exhorting them to remain in the faith, and that through many afflictions we must enter into the kingdom of God.

23 And having appointed elders for them church by church, having prayed with fastings, they entrusted them to the Lord in whom they had believed.

24 And having passed through Pisidia, they came to Pamphylia.

25 And having spoken the word in Perga, they went down to Attalia.

26 And from there they sailed away to Antioch, from where they had been handed over to the grace of God for the work which they fulfilled.

27 And having come and having gathered the church, they announced all things which God did with them, and that he opened a door of faith to the nations.

28 And there they were spending no little time with the disciples.

Chapter 15

1 And some, having come down from Judea, were teaching the brothers that unless you are circumcised by the custom of Moses, you cannot be saved.

2 When therefore no little dissension and dispute arose for Paul and Barnabas with them, they appointed Paul and Barnabas and some others of them to go up to the apostles and elders into Jerusalem concerning this question.

3 They therefore indeed, having been sent onward by the church, were passing through Phoenicia and Samaria, recounting the conversion of the nations, and were making great joy for all the brothers.

4 And having come to Jerusalem, they were received by the church and the apostles and the elders, and announced all things which God did with them.

5 But some of those from the sect of the Pharisees who had believed rose up, saying that it is necessary to circumcise them and command them to keep the law of Moses.

6 And the apostles and the elders were gathered to see concerning this matter.

7 And much dispute having occurred, Peter, having risen, said to them, Men, brothers, you know that from ancient days God chose among us that through my mouth the nations should hear the word of the good news and believe.

8 And God, the heart-knower, testified to them, having given them the Holy Spirit just as also to us,

9 and distinguished nothing between both us and them, having cleansed their hearts by faith.

10 Now therefore why do you test God, to lay a yoke upon the neck of the disciples which neither our fathers nor we were strong enough to bear?

11 But through the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ we believe to be saved, in the manner they also are.

12 And all the multitude became silent and were hearing Barnabas and Paul explaining all the signs and wonders God did among the nations through them.

13 And after they became silent, James answered, saying, Men, brothers, hear me.

14 Simeon explained how God first visited to take from nations a people upon his name.

15 And with this the words of the prophets agree, just as it is written,

16 After these things I will return and rebuild the tent of David which has fallen, and its demolished things I will rebuild, and I will set it upright,

17 so that the remaining ones of people may seek out the Lord, and all the nations upon whom my name has been called upon them, says the Lord who does all these things.

18 All his works are known to God from the age.

19 Because of this I judge not to trouble those from the nations turning to God,

20 but to write to them to abstain from the pollutions of the idols and fornication and what is strangled and blood.

21 For Moses from ancient generations has those proclaiming him city by city, being read in the synagogues every Sabbath.

22 Then it seemed good to the apostles and the elders with the whole church, having chosen men from them, to send to Antioch with Paul and Barnabas Judas surnamed Barsabas and Silas, leading men among the brothers,

23 having written through their hand these things: The apostles and the elders and the brothers, to the brothers from nations throughout Antioch and Syria and Cilicia, greetings.

24 Since we heard that some going out from us troubled you with words, unsettling your souls, saying to be circumcised and keep the law, to whom we gave no instruction,

25 it seemed good to us, having become of one accord, having chosen men, to send to you with our beloved Barnabas and Paul,

26 people who have handed over their lives for the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.

27 We have therefore sent Judas and Silas, themselves also reporting the same things through speech.

28 For it seemed good to the Holy Spirit and to us to lay upon you no further burden except these necessary things:

29 to abstain from things sacrificed to idols and blood and what is strangled and fornication, from which keeping yourselves, you will do well. Be strong.

30 They therefore indeed, having been released, came to Antioch, and having gathered the multitude, delivered the letter.

31 And having read, they rejoiced at the encouragement.

32 And Judas and Silas, themselves also being prophets, exhorted the brothers through much speech and strengthened them.

33 And having spent time, they were released with peace from the brothers to the apostles.

34 But it seemed good to Silas to remain there.

35 But Paul and Barnabas were spending time in Antioch, teaching and proclaiming as good news the word of the Lord, with many others also.

36 And after some days Paul said to Barnabas, Let us now return and visit our brothers in every city in which we proclaimed the word of the Lord, how they are.

37 And Barnabas took counsel to take along John called Mark.

38 But Paul was considering it fitting not to take along this man, who departed from them from Pamphylia and did not go with them into the work.

39 There arose therefore a sharp contention, so that they separated from each other, and Barnabas, having taken Mark, sailed out to Cyprus.

40 But Paul, having chosen Silas, went out, having been entrusted to the grace of God by the brothers.

41 And he was passing through Syria and Cilicia, strengthening the churches.

Chapter 16

1 And he arrived at Derbe and Lystra, and look, a certain disciple was there named Timothy, son of a certain believing Jewish woman, but of a Greek father,

2 who was attested by the brothers in Lystra and Iconium.

3 Paul wished this man to go out with him, and having taken him, circumcised him because of the Jews in those places, for all knew his father, that he was a Greek.

4 And as they were passing through the cities, they were delivering to them to keep the decrees decided by the apostles and elders in Jerusalem.

5 The churches therefore indeed were being strengthened in the faith and abounding in number daily.

6 And having passed through Phrygia and the Galatian country, having been forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia,

7 having come toward Mysia, they were trying to go toward Bithynia, and the Spirit did not allow them.

8 And having passed by Mysia, they went down to Troas.

9 And a vision appeared to Paul through the night: a certain Macedonian man was standing, exhorting him and saying, Cross into Macedonia and help us.

10 And when he saw the vision, immediately we sought to go out into Macedonia, concluding that the Lord has called us to proclaim good news to them.

11 Having therefore put out from Troas, we sailed straight to Samothrace, and on the following day to Neapolis,

12 and from there to Philippi, which is a foremost city of the district of Macedonia, a colony. And we were spending some days in this city.

13 And on the Sabbath day we went out outside the city by a river, where a place of prayer was supposed to be, and having sat down, we were speaking to the women who came together.

14 And a certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple from the city of Thyatira, worshiping God, was hearing, whose heart the Lord opened to attend to the things spoken by Paul.

15 And when she was baptized, and her house, she exhorted us, saying, If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, enter into my house and stay. And she urged us strongly.

16 And it happened as we were going to prayer that a certain servant girl having a spirit of Python met us, who was providing much profit to her masters by divining.

17 She, having followed after Paul and us, was crying out, saying, These people are slaves of the Most High God, who proclaim to us a way of salvation.

18 And she was doing this for many days. But Paul, having become greatly troubled and having turned, said to the spirit, I command you in the name of Jesus Christ to come out from her. And it came out in that very hour.

19 But her masters, having seen that the hope of their profit went out, having seized Paul and Silas, dragged them into the marketplace before the rulers.

20 And having brought them to the magistrates, they said, These people greatly disturb our city, being Jews,

21 and proclaim customs which it is not lawful for us to receive or do, being Romans.

22 And the crowd rose together against them, and the magistrates, having torn off their garments, were commanding them to be beaten with rods.

23 And having laid many blows upon them, they cast them into prison, having commanded the jailer to keep them securely,

24 who, having received such a command, cast them into the inner prison and secured their feet in the wood.

25 And about midnight Paul and Silas, praying, were singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.

26 And suddenly a great earthquake occurred, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken, and immediately all the doors were opened, and the bonds of all were loosed.

27 And the jailer, having become awake and having seen the prison doors opened, having drawn a sword, was about to kill himself, supposing the prisoners to have escaped.

28 But Paul called with a loud voice, saying, Do no evil to yourself, for we all are here.

29 And having asked for lights, he leaped in, and having become trembling, fell before Paul and Silas.

30 And having brought them forward outside, he said, Sirs, what must I do so that I may be saved?

31 And they said, Believe upon the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your house.

32 And they spoke to him the word of the Lord, and to all those in his house.

33 And having taken them in that hour of the night, he washed them from the wounds, and he himself and all his people were baptized immediately.

34 And having brought them up into his house, he set a table before them, and exulted with all the house, having believed God.

35 And when day came, the magistrates sent the rod-bearers, saying, Release those people.

36 And the jailer reported these words to Paul, that the magistrates have sent so that you may be released. Now therefore go out and go in peace.

37 But Paul said to them, Having beaten us publicly, uncondemned people, being Romans, they cast us into prison, and now do they cast us out secretly? No indeed, but let them themselves come and lead us out.

38 And the rod-bearers announced these sayings to the magistrates, and they feared, having heard that they are Romans.

39 And having come, they entreated them, and having led them out, were asking them to go out from the city.

40 And having gone out from the prison, they entered to Lydia, and having seen the brothers, encouraged them and went out.

Chapter 17

1 And having journeyed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where the synagogue of the Jews was.

2 And according to Paul's custom, he entered to them, and for three Sabbaths was reasoning with them from the Scriptures,

3 opening and setting forth that the Christ had to suffer and rise from the dead, and that this is the Christ, Jesus whom I proclaim to you.

4 And some of them were persuaded and joined to Paul and Silas, and a great multitude of the worshiping Greeks, and not a few of the foremost women.

5 But the disobeying Jews, having become jealous and having taken some wicked men from the marketplace idlers, and having made a crowd, were disturbing the city, and having come upon Jason's house, were seeking to bring them to the populace.

6 But not having found them, they were dragging Jason and some brothers before the city rulers, crying that these who upset the inhabited world are present here also,

7 whom Jason has received, and all these act against Caesar's decrees, saying that there is another king, Jesus.

8 And they troubled the crowd and the city rulers hearing these things.

9 And having received the security from Jason and the rest, they released them.

10 And the brothers immediately through the night sent out both Paul and Silas to Berea, who, having come, were going into the synagogue of the Jews.

11 And these were nobler than those in Thessalonica, who received the word with all eagerness, daily examining the Scriptures whether these things were thus.

12 Many therefore indeed of them believed, and not a few of the prominent Greek women and men.

13 But when the Jews from Thessalonica knew that in Berea also the word of God was proclaimed by Paul, they came there also, shaking the crowds.

14 And then immediately the brothers sent Paul out to go as toward the sea, but both Silas and Timothy were remaining there.

15 And those conducting Paul brought him as far as Athens, and having received a command to Silas and Timothy that they should come to him as quickly as possible, were going out.

16 And in Athens, while Paul was awaiting them, his spirit was being provoked within him as he beheld the city being full of idols.

17 He therefore indeed was reasoning in the synagogue with the Jews and those worshiping, and in the marketplace every day with those happening to be there.

18 And some of the Epicurean and Stoic philosophers were encountering him, and some were saying, What might this seed-picker wish to say? But others, He seems to be a proclaimer of foreign divinities, because he was proclaiming Jesus and the resurrection to them as good news.

19 And having taken hold of him, they brought him upon the Areopagus, saying, Can we know what is this new teaching spoken by you?

20 For you bring some strange things into our hearing. We wish therefore to know what these things might mean.

21 And all Athenians and the visiting strangers were spending leisure in nothing else than saying something and hearing something newer.

22 And Paul, having stood in the midst of the Areopagus, said, Athenian men, in all things I behold you as more reverent toward divinities.

23 For passing through and observing your objects of worship, I found also an altar on which had been inscribed, To an unknown god. The one therefore whom you worship in ignorance, this one I proclaim to you.

24 God, who made the world and all things in it, this one, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not dwell in sanctuaries made by hands,

25 nor is he served by people's hands as needing anything, himself giving all life and breath in all things.

26 And he made from one blood every nation of people to dwell upon all the face of the earth, having determined seasons appointed beforehand and the boundaries of their dwelling,

27 to seek the Lord, whether perhaps they might feel for him and find him, although indeed he is not far from each one of us.

28 For in him we live and move and are, as also some of the poets among you have said, For we also are his offspring.

29 Being therefore offspring of God, we ought not to suppose the divine to be like gold or silver or stone, an engraving of a person's art and thought.

30 God therefore indeed, having overlooked the times of ignorance, now commands all people everywhere to repent,

31 because he set a day in which he is about to judge the inhabited world in righteousness by a man whom he determined, having provided assurance to all, having raised him from the dead.

32 But having heard a resurrection of dead people, some were mocking, but others said, We will hear you again concerning this.

33 And thus Paul went out from their midst.

34 But some men, having joined themselves to him, believed, among whom also were Dionysius the Areopagite and a woman named Damaris, and others with them.

Chapter 18

1 And after these things Paul, having departed from Athens, came to Corinth.

2 And having found a certain Jew named Aquila, a Pontian by birth, recently come from Italy, and Priscilla his wife, because Claudius had commanded all the Jews to depart from Rome, he approached them.

3 And because he was of the same trade, he was remaining with them and working, for they were tentmakers by trade.

4 And he was reasoning in the synagogue every Sabbath, and persuading Jews and Greeks.

5 And when both Silas and Timothy came down from Macedonia, Paul was constrained in spirit, solemnly testifying to the Jews that Jesus is the Christ.

6 But as they were opposing and blaspheming, having shaken off the garments, he said to them, Your blood upon your head; I am clean. From now I will go to the nations.

7 And having departed from there, he came into the house of someone named Justus, worshiping God, whose house was adjoining the synagogue.

8 And Crispus, the ruler of the synagogue, believed the Lord with all his house, and many of the Corinthians, hearing, were believing and being baptized.

9 And the Lord said through a vision in the night to Paul, Do not fear, but speak and do not become silent,

10 because I am with you, and no one will set upon you to harm you, because I have many people in this city.

11 And he stayed a year and six months, teaching among them the word of God.

12 And while Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews rose against Paul with one accord and brought him before the judgment seat,

13 saying that this man persuades people to worship God contrary to the law.

14 And when Paul was about to open the mouth, Gallio said to the Jews, If therefore indeed it were some injustice or wicked villainy, O Jews, according to reason I would bear with you.

15 But if it is a question concerning a word and names and the law among you, you yourselves shall see to it, for I do not wish to be a judge of these things.

16 And he drove them away from the judgment seat.

17 But all the Greeks, having seized Sosthenes the ruler of the synagogue, were striking him before the judgment seat, and Gallio cared for none of these things.

18 And Paul, having remained still considerable days, having bid farewell to the brothers, was sailing out to Syria, and with him Priscilla and Aquila, having shorn the head in Cenchreae, for he had a vow.

19 And he arrived at Ephesus and left them there, but he himself, having entered into the synagogue, reasoned with the Jews.

20 And when they asked him to stay a longer time with them, he did not consent,

21 but bade farewell to them, saying, I must by all means keep the coming feast in Jerusalem, but I will return again to you, God willing. And he put out from Ephesus.

22 And having come down to Caesarea, having gone up and greeted the church, he went down to Antioch.

23 And having spent some time, he went out, passing through in succession the Galatian country and Phrygia, strengthening all the disciples.

24 And a certain Jew named Apollos, an Alexandrian by birth, an eloquent man, arrived at Ephesus, being mighty in the Scriptures.

25 This man had been instructed in the way of the Lord, and boiling in spirit, was speaking and teaching accurately the things concerning the Lord, knowing only the baptism of John.

26 And this man began to speak openly in the synagogue, and Aquila and Priscilla, having heard him, took him to themselves and set out to him more accurately the way of God.

27 And when he wished to pass into Achaia, the brothers, having encouraged him, wrote to the disciples to receive him, who, having come, contributed much to those who had believed through grace.

28 For he was vehemently refuting the Jews publicly, showing through the Scriptures that Jesus is the Christ.

Chapter 19

1 And it happened while Apollos was in Corinth that Paul, having passed through the upper parts, came to Ephesus, and having found some disciples,

2 he said to them, Did you receive Holy Spirit, having believed? And they said to him, But we did not even hear whether there is Holy Spirit.

3 And he said to them, Into what therefore were you baptized? And they said, Into John's baptism.

4 And Paul said, John indeed baptized a baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe in the one coming after him, that is, in Christ Jesus.

5 And having heard, they were baptized into the name of the Lord Jesus.

6 And when Paul laid hands upon them, the Holy Spirit came upon them, and they were speaking in tongues and prophesying.

7 And all the men were about twelve.

8 And having entered into the synagogue, he was speaking openly for three months, reasoning and persuading the things concerning the kingdom of God.

9 But when some were being hardened and disobeying, speaking evil of the Way before the multitude, having departed from them, he separated the disciples, reasoning daily in the school of a certain Tyrannus.

10 And this happened for two years, so that all those dwelling in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks.

11 And God was doing no ordinary mighty works through Paul's hands,

12 so that even handkerchiefs or aprons from his skin were being carried to the sick, and the diseases were departing from them, and the wicked spirits were going out from them.

13 But some of the itinerant Jewish exorcists attempted to name upon those having the wicked spirits the name of the Lord Jesus, saying, We adjure you by Jesus whom Paul proclaims.

14 And there were certain seven sons of Sceva, a Jewish chief priest, doing this.

15 But the wicked spirit, answering, said, Jesus I know, and Paul I am acquainted with, but who are you?

16 And the man in whom the wicked spirit was, having leaped upon them and having mastered them, prevailed against them, so that they fled out from that house naked and wounded.

17 And this became known to all, both Jews and Greeks dwelling in Ephesus, and fear fell upon them all, and the name of the Lord Jesus was being magnified.

18 And many of those who had believed were coming, confessing and announcing their deeds.

19 And considerable numbers of those who practiced the magic arts, having brought the books together, were burning them before all, and they counted together their prices and found fifty thousand of silver.

20 Thus the word of the Lord was increasing mightily and prevailing.

21 And when these things were fulfilled, Paul set in the spirit, having passed through Macedonia and Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying that after I have come there, I must also see Rome.

22 And having sent to Macedonia two of those serving him, Timothy and Erastus, he himself stayed a time in Asia.

23 And at that season there arose no little disturbance concerning the Way.

24 For a certain man named Demetrius, a silversmith, making silver sanctuaries of Artemis, was providing no little profit to the craftsmen,

25 whom, having gathered together, and the workers about such things, he said, Men, you know that our prosperity is from this work.

26 And you behold and hear that not only of Ephesus, but of almost all Asia, this Paul, having persuaded, turned aside a considerable crowd, saying that those made through hands are not gods.

27 And not only does this trade of ours risk coming into disrepute, but also the temple of the great goddess Artemis being reckoned as nothing, and her majesty also about to be taken down, whom all Asia and the inhabited world worship.

28 And having heard and having become full of anger, they were crying out, saying, Great is Artemis of the Ephesians.

29 And the whole city was filled with confusion, and they rushed with one accord into the theater, having seized Gaius and Aristarchus, Macedonians, fellow travelers of Paul.

30 And when Paul wished to enter to the populace, the disciples were not allowing him.

31 And some also of the Asiarchs, being his friends, having sent to him, were exhorting him not to give himself into the theater.

32 Some therefore indeed were crying one thing, others another, for the assembly was confused, and most did not know for what reason they had come together.

33 And from the crowd they brought forward Alexander, the Jews having put him forward, and Alexander, having motioned with the hand, wished to defend himself to the populace.

34 But when they recognized that he is a Jew, one voice came from all, for about two hours crying, Great is Artemis of the Ephesians.

35 And the secretary, having quieted the crowd, says, Ephesian men, for who is a person who does not know that the city of the Ephesians is temple-keeper of the great goddess Artemis and of the thing fallen from Zeus?

36 These things therefore being indisputable, it is necessary that you be quieted and do nothing rash.

37 For you brought these men, neither temple-robbers nor blaspheming your goddess.

38 If therefore indeed Demetrius and the craftsmen with him have a matter against anyone, court days are being held and there are proconsuls; let them accuse each other.

39 But if you seek anything concerning other matters, it will be resolved in the lawful assembly.

40 For we also risk being accused of uprising concerning today, no cause existing concerning which we will be able to give an account of this gathering.

41 And having said these things, he dismissed the assembly.

Chapter 20

1 And after the uproar ceased, Paul, having summoned the disciples and having greeted them, went out to go to Macedonia.

2 And having passed through those parts and having exhorted them with much speech, he came to Greece.

3 And having spent three months, when a plot was made against him by the Jews as he was about to put out to Syria, he resolved to return through Macedonia.

4 And Sopater of Berea was accompanying him as far as Asia, and of Thessalonians Aristarchus and Secundus, and Gaius of Derbe and Timothy, and Asians Tychicus and Trophimus.

5 These, having gone ahead, were awaiting us in Troas.

6 But we sailed out after the days of Unleavened Bread from Philippi, and came to them into Troas within five days, where we spent seven days.

7 And on the first day of the week, when the disciples were gathered to break bread, Paul was reasoning with them, about to go out on the next day, and was prolonging the speech until midnight.

8 And there were considerable lamps in the upper room where they were gathered.

9 And a certain young man named Eutychus, sitting upon the window, being borne down by deep sleep as Paul was reasoning longer, having been borne down by the sleep, fell down from the third story and was taken up dead.

10 But Paul, having gone down, fell upon him, and having embraced him, said, Do not be disturbed, for his soul is in him.

11 And having gone up and having broken bread and tasted, and having conversed for a considerable time until dawn, thus he went out.

12 And they brought the boy alive, and were comforted not moderately.

13 But we, having gone ahead to the boat, put out to Assos, about to take up Paul from there, for thus he had arranged, himself about to go on foot.

14 And when he met us at Assos, having taken him up, we came to Mitylene.

15 And having sailed away from there, on the following day we arrived opposite Chios, and on the next we approached Samos, and having remained in Trogyllium, on the following day we came to Miletus.

16 For Paul decided to sail past Ephesus, so that he might not come to spend time in Asia, for he was hurrying, if it were possible for him, to be in Jerusalem on the day of Pentecost.

17 And from Miletus, having sent to Ephesus, he summoned the elders of the church.

18 And when they came to him, he said to them, You know from the first day on which I stepped into Asia how I was with you all the time,

19 serving the Lord with all humility and many tears and trials which happened to me in the plots of the Jews,

20 how I withheld nothing of the beneficial things from announcing to you and teaching you publicly and house by house,

21 solemnly testifying to both Jews and Greeks repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ.

22 And now look, I, bound in the spirit, go to Jerusalem, not knowing the things that will meet me in it,

23 except that the Holy Spirit city by city solemnly testifies, saying that bonds and afflictions await me.

24 But I make account of none of these things, nor hold my life precious to myself, so as to complete my course with joy and the service which I received from the Lord Jesus, to testify solemnly to the good news of the grace of God.

25 And now look, I know that you all, among whom I went through proclaiming the kingdom of God, will no longer see my face.

26 Because of this I testify to you on today's day that I am clean from the blood of all.

27 For I did not withhold from announcing to you all the counsel of God.

28 Pay attention therefore to yourselves and to all the flock in which the Holy Spirit placed you as overseers, to shepherd the church of God, which he acquired through his own blood.

29 For I know this, that after my departure heavy wolves will enter among you, not sparing the flock.

30 And from you yourselves men will rise, speaking perverted things to draw away the disciples after them.

31 Because of this stay awake, remembering that for three years night and day I did not cease admonishing each one with tears.

32 And now I entrust you, brothers, to God and to the word of his grace, which is able to build up and give you inheritance among all those sanctified.

33 I desired no one's silver or gold or clothing.

34 And you yourselves know that these hands served my needs and those being with me.

35 I showed you all things, that laboring thus it is necessary to help the weak, and remember the words of the Lord Jesus, that he himself said, It is blessed to give rather than receive.

36 And having said these things, having placed his knees down, he prayed with them all.

37 And considerable weeping of all occurred, and having fallen upon Paul's neck, they were kissing him,

38 being pained especially at the word which he had said, that they are no longer about to behold his face. And they were sending him onward to the boat.

Chapter 21

1 And when it happened that we put out, having been torn away from them, having sailed straight, we came to Cos, and on the next day to Rhodes, and from there to Patara.

2 And having found a boat crossing to Phoenicia, having embarked, we put out.

3 And having sighted Cyprus and having left it on the left, we were sailing to Syria and landed at Tyre, for there the boat was unloading the cargo.

4 And having found the disciples, we remained there seven days, who were saying to Paul through the Spirit not to go up to Jerusalem.

5 And when it happened that we completed the days, having gone out, we were going, all sending us onward with wives and children as far as outside the city, and having placed our knees down upon the shore, we prayed.

6 And having greeted each other, we embarked into the boat, but they returned to their own things.

7 And we, having completed the voyage from Tyre, arrived at Ptolemais, and having greeted the brothers, stayed one day with them.

8 And on the next day those around Paul, having gone out, came to Caesarea, and having entered into the house of Philip the evangelist, being of the seven, we stayed with him.

9 And this man had four virgin daughters prophesying.

10 And while we were remaining many days, a certain prophet named Agabus came down from Judea,

11 and having come to us and having taken Paul's belt, and having bound his own hands and feet, said, These things the Holy Spirit says: The man whose belt this is, thus the Jews in Jerusalem will bind and hand over into hands of nations.

12 And when we heard these things, both we and the local people were exhorting him not to go up to Jerusalem.

13 But Paul answered, What do you do, weeping and crushing my heart? For I am ready not only to be bound, but also to die in Jerusalem for the name of the Lord Jesus.

14 And when he was not being persuaded, we became quiet, having said, Let the will of the Lord happen.

15 And after these days, having packed up, we were going up to Jerusalem.

16 And some of the disciples from Caesarea also went with us, bringing us to one with whom we might lodge, a certain Mnason, a Cypriot, an early disciple.

17 And when we came to Jerusalem, the brothers gladly received us.

18 And on the following day Paul was going in with us to James, and all the elders came.

19 And having greeted them, he was explaining one by one each of the things which God did among the nations through his service.

20 And having heard, they were glorifying the Lord, and said to him, You behold, brother, how many tens of thousands there are of Jews who have believed, and all are zealots of the law.

21 But they were informed concerning you that you teach apostasy from Moses to all the Jews throughout the nations, saying that they should not circumcise the children nor walk in the customs.

22 What therefore is it? A multitude must by all means come together, for they will hear that you have come.

23 Do therefore this which we say to you. We have four men having a vow upon themselves.

24 Having taken these, purify yourself with them and spend on them, so that they may shave the head, and all may know that the things of which they have been informed concerning you are nothing, but you yourself also walk in order, keeping the law.

25 But concerning the nations who have believed, we wrote, having judged that they keep nothing of this sort, except to guard themselves from both the thing sacrificed to idols and blood and what is strangled and fornication.

26 Then Paul, having taken the men, on the following day, having been purified with them, was entering into the temple, announcing the fulfillment of the days of purification, until the offering was offered for each one of them.

27 And when the seven days were about to be completed, the Jews from Asia, having beheld him in the temple, were confounding all the crowd and laid hands upon him,

28 crying, Israelite men, help! This is the person teaching all everywhere against the people and the law and this place, and furthermore he also brought Greeks into the temple and has made this holy place common.

29 For they had previously seen Trophimus the Ephesian in the city with him, whom they were supposing Paul brought into the temple.

30 And the whole city was stirred, and a running together of the people occurred, and having seized Paul, they were dragging him outside the temple, and immediately the doors were shut.

31 And while they were seeking to kill him, a report went up to the commander of a thousand of the cohort that all Jerusalem has been confounded,

32 who, immediately having taken soldiers and centurions, ran down upon them, but they, having seen the commander of a thousand and the soldiers, ceased striking Paul.

33 Then the commander of a thousand, having drawn near, seized him and commanded him to be bound with two chains, and was inquiring who he might be and what he has done.

34 But some were crying one thing, others another, in the crowd, and not being able to know the certainty because of the uproar, he commanded him to be led into the barracks.

35 And when he came upon the steps, it happened that he was carried by the soldiers because of the violence of the crowd.

36 For the multitude of the people was following, crying, Take him away.

37 And Paul, about to be brought into the barracks, says to the commander of a thousand, Is it lawful for me to say something to you? And he said, Do you know Greek?

38 Are you not then the Egyptian who before these days caused an uprising and led out into the wilderness the four thousand men of the dagger-men?

39 But Paul said, I indeed am a Jewish person, a Tarsian of Cilicia, a citizen of no insignificant city. And I plead with you, permit me to speak to the people.

40 And when he permitted, Paul, standing upon the steps, motioned with the hand to the people, and when much silence came, he addressed them in the Hebrew dialect, saying,

Chapter 22

1 Men, brothers and fathers, hear my defense to you now.

2 And having heard that he was addressing them in the Hebrew dialect, they provided more quiet. And he says,

3 I indeed am a Jewish man, born in Tarsus of Cilicia, but reared in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, educated according to exactness of the ancestral law, being a zealot of God, just as you all are today,

4 who persecuted this Way as far as death, binding and handing over into prisons both men and women,

5 as also the high priest testifies to me, and all the eldership, from whom also, having received letters to the brothers, I was going to Damascus to bring those there also bound into Jerusalem so that they might be punished.

6 And it happened to me, going and drawing near Damascus about midday, that suddenly a considerable light from heaven flashed around me.

7 And I fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to me, Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?

8 And I answered, Who are you, Lord? And he said to me, I am Jesus the Nazarene whom you persecute.

9 And those being with me indeed beheld the light and became fearful, but did not hear the voice of the one speaking to me.

10 And I said, What shall I do, Lord? And the Lord said to me, Rise and go to Damascus, and there it will be spoken to you concerning all things appointed for you to do.

11 And as I was not seeing because of the glory of that light, being led by hand by those being with me, I came to Damascus.

12 And a certain Ananias, a man pious according to the law, attested by all the Jews dwelling there,

13 having come to me and having stood by, said to me, Saul, brother, receive sight. And I in that very hour received sight toward him.

14 And he said, The God of our fathers appointed you beforehand to know his will and see the Righteous One and hear a voice from his mouth,

15 because you will be a witness to him before all people of the things which you have seen and heard.

16 And now why do you delay? Rise, be baptized and wash away your sins, having called upon the name of the Lord.

17 And it happened to me, having returned to Jerusalem and while I was praying in the temple, that I came into a trance,

18 and saw him saying to me, Hurry and go out quickly from Jerusalem, because they will not receive your testimony concerning me.

19 And I said, Lord, they themselves know that I was imprisoning and beating in the synagogues those believing upon you.

20 And when the blood of Stephen your witness was being poured out, I myself also was standing by and consenting to his killing, and guarding the garments of those killing him.

21 And he said to me, Go, because I will send you out far away to nations.

22 And they were hearing him until this word, and raised their voice, saying, Take such a man away from the earth, for it was not fitting for him to live.

23 And as they were crying out and throwing the garments and casting dust into the air,

24 the commander of a thousand commanded him to be led into the barracks, having said that he be examined with scourges, so that he might know for what reason they were shouting thus against him.

25 And as he stretched him out with the straps, Paul said to the centurion standing by, Is it lawful for you to scourge a Roman person, and uncondemned?

26 And the centurion, having heard, having approached, reported to the commander of a thousand, saying, See what you are about to do, for this person is a Roman.

27 And the commander of a thousand, having approached, said to him, Tell me whether you are a Roman. And he said, Yes.

28 And the commander of a thousand answered, I acquired this citizenship for much money. But Paul said, But I have even been born to it.

29 Immediately therefore those about to examine him departed from him, and the commander of a thousand also feared, having learned that he is a Roman and that he had bound him.

30 And on the next day, wishing to know the certainty as to why he is accused by the Jews, he loosed him from the bonds, and commanded the chief priests and all their council to come, and having brought Paul down, stood him before them.

Chapter 23

1 And Paul, having looked intently at the council, said, Men, brothers, I have conducted myself for God with all good conscience until this day.

2 But the high priest Ananias commanded those standing by him to strike his mouth.

3 Then Paul said to him, God is about to strike you, whitewashed wall. And do you sit judging me according to the law, and breaking the law command me to be struck?

4 And those standing by said, Do you revile God's high priest?

5 And Paul said, I did not know, brothers, that he is high priest, for it is written, You shall not speak badly of a ruler of your people.

6 And Paul, having known that the one part is of Sadducees and the other of Pharisees, cried in the council, Men, brothers, I am a Pharisee, a son of a Pharisee. Concerning hope and resurrection of the dead I am judged.

7 And when he spoke this, dissension arose of the Pharisees and the Sadducees, and the multitude was divided.

8 For Sadducees indeed say there is no resurrection, nor angel nor spirit, but Pharisees confess both.

9 And a great outcry arose, and the scribes of the part of the Pharisees, having risen, were fighting fiercely, saying, We find no evil in this person, but if a spirit spoke to him, or an angel, let us not fight against God.

10 And much dissension having arisen, the commander of a thousand, having feared lest Paul be torn apart by them, commanded the troops to go down and snatch him from their midst and bring him into the barracks.

11 And on the following night the Lord, having stood by him, said, Take courage, Paul, for as you testified solemnly to the things concerning me in Jerusalem, thus you must also testify in Rome.

12 And when day came, some of the Jews, having made a gathering, put themselves under a curse, saying neither to eat nor drink until they kill Paul.

13 And those having made this conspiracy were more than forty,

14 who, having approached the chief priests and the elders, said, With a curse we put ourselves under a curse to taste nothing until we kill Paul.

15 Now therefore you with the council make it known to the commander of a thousand that he should bring him down to you tomorrow, as though you are about to determine more accurately the things concerning him, but we are ready to kill him before he draws near.

16 But the son of Paul's sister, having heard the ambush, having come and entered into the barracks, reported to Paul.

17 And Paul, having summoned one of the centurions, said, Bring this young man to the commander of a thousand, for he has something to report to him.

18 He therefore indeed, having taken him, brought him to the commander of a thousand and says, The prisoner Paul, having summoned me, asked to bring this young man to you, having something to speak to you.

19 And the commander of a thousand, having taken hold of his hand and having withdrawn privately, was inquiring, What is it which you have to report to me?

20 And he said that the Jews agreed to ask you that tomorrow you bring Paul down into the council, as though they are about to inquire something more accurately concerning him.

21 You therefore do not be persuaded by them, for more than forty men from them lie in ambush for him, who put themselves under a curse neither to eat nor drink until they kill him, and now they are ready, awaiting the promise from you.

22 The commander of a thousand therefore indeed released the young man, having commanded him to tell no one that you made these things known to me.

23 And having summoned a certain two of the centurions, he said, Prepare two hundred soldiers so that they may go as far as Caesarea, and seventy horsemen and two hundred spearmen, from the third hour of the night,

24 and provide beasts, so that having mounted Paul, they may bring him safely to Felix the governor,

25 having written a letter containing this form:

26 Claudius Lysias, to the most excellent governor Felix, greetings.

27 This man, having been seized by the Jews and about to be killed by them, having come upon them with the troops, I delivered him, having learned that he is a Roman.

28 And wishing to know the cause for which they were accusing him, I brought him down into their council,

29 whom I found accused concerning questions of their law, but having no charge worthy of death or bonds.

30 And when it was disclosed to me that a plot against the man was about to be made by the Jews, immediately I sent to you, having commanded his accusers also to say the things against him before you. Be strong.

31 The soldiers therefore indeed, according to what had been commanded them, having taken Paul, brought him through the night to Antipatris.

32 And on the next day, having allowed the horsemen to go with him, they returned to the barracks,

33 who, having entered into Caesarea and delivered the letter to the governor, presented Paul also to him.

34 And the governor, having read and having asked from what province he is, and having learned that he is from Cilicia,

35 said, I will hear you thoroughly when your accusers also come. And he commanded him to be guarded in Herod's praetorium.

Chapter 24

1 And after five days the high priest Ananias came down with the elders and a certain orator Tertullus, who made a complaint to the governor against Paul.

2 And when he was called, Tertullus began to accuse, saying,

3 Obtaining much peace through you, and improvements occurring for this nation through your foresight, in every way and everywhere we receive it, most excellent Felix, with all thanksgiving.

4 But so that I may not hinder you further, I entreat you to hear us briefly in your fairness.

5 For having found this man a plague, and stirring dissension among all the Jews throughout the inhabited world, and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes,

6 who also attempted to profane the temple, whom we also seized and wished to judge according to our law,

7 but Lysias the commander of a thousand, having come, with much violence led him away from our hands,

8 having commanded his accusers to come before you, from whom you yourself, having examined, will be able to learn concerning all these things of which we accuse him.

9 And the Jews also agreed, asserting that these things are thus.

10 And Paul answered, when the governor motioned to him to speak, Knowing that you have been a judge for this nation for many years, I defend the things concerning myself more cheerfully,

11 you being able to know that it is not more than twelve days for me since I went up to worship in Jerusalem.

12 And neither in the temple did they find me reasoning with anyone or making a gathering of a crowd, nor in the synagogues nor throughout the city,

13 nor can they present me concerning the things of which they now accuse me.

14 But I confess this to you, that according to the Way which they call a sect, thus I worship the ancestral God, believing all the things according to the law and written in the prophets,

15 having hope toward God, which these themselves also await, that there is about to be a resurrection of the dead, both righteous and unrighteous.

16 And in this I myself practice to have a conscience without offense toward God and people continually.

17 And after many years I came to make alms to my nation and offerings,

18 in which they found me purified in the temple, not with a crowd nor with uproar, but some Jews from Asia,

19 who ought to be present before you and accuse, if they should have anything against me.

20 Or let these themselves say whether they found any injustice in me when I stood before the council,

21 except concerning this one utterance which I cried out, standing among them, that concerning resurrection of the dead I am judged today by you.

22 But Felix, having heard these things, deferred them, knowing more accurately the things concerning the Way, having said, When Lysias the commander of a thousand comes down, I will determine the things concerning you,

23 and having commanded the centurion that Paul be kept and have relaxation, and to forbid none of his own people to serve or approach him.

24 And after some days Felix, having come with Drusilla his wife, being Jewish, summoned Paul and heard him concerning faith in Christ.

25 And as he was reasoning concerning righteousness and self-control and the judgment about to be, Felix, having become fearful, answered, For the present, go, and having obtained a season, I will call for you.

26 At the same time also hoping that money would be given him by Paul, so that he might release him, because of this also, summoning him more frequently, he was conversing with him.

27 And two years having been fulfilled, Felix received a successor, Porcius Festus, and wishing to lay up favors with the Jews, Felix left Paul bound.

Chapter 25

1 Festus therefore, having entered upon the province, after three days went up to Jerusalem from Caesarea.

2 And the high priest and the foremost of the Jews made a complaint to him against Paul, and were entreating him,

3 asking a favor against him, that he summon him to Jerusalem, making an ambush to kill him along the road.

4 Festus therefore indeed answered that Paul is kept in Caesarea, and that he himself is about to go out quickly.

5 Those therefore able among you, he says, having gone down together, if there is anything in this man, let them accuse him.

6 And having spent more than ten days among them, having gone down to Caesarea, on the next day, having sat upon the judgment seat, he commanded Paul to be brought.

7 And when he came, the Jews who had come down from Jerusalem stood around, bringing many and heavy accusations against Paul, which they were not strong enough to demonstrate,

8 while he was defending himself, that neither against the law of the Jews nor against the temple nor against Caesar did I sin in anything.

9 But Festus, wishing to lay up a favor with the Jews, answering Paul, said, Do you wish, having gone up to Jerusalem, to be judged there concerning these things before me?

10 But Paul said, I am standing before Caesar's judgment seat, where I must be judged. I wronged Jews in nothing, as you also know better.

11 For if indeed I wrong and have done anything worthy of death, I do not refuse to die. But if there is nothing of the things of which these accuse me, no one can grant me to them. I appeal to Caesar.

12 Then Festus, having spoken together with the council, answered, You have appealed to Caesar; to Caesar you will go.

13 And some days having elapsed, Agrippa the king and Bernice arrived at Caesarea to greet Festus.

14 And as they were spending many days there, Festus laid before the king the things concerning Paul, saying, There is a certain man left by Felix as a prisoner,

15 concerning whom, when I came to Jerusalem, the chief priests and the elders of the Jews made a complaint, asking a judgment against him.

16 To whom I answered that it is not a custom for Romans to grant any person to destruction before the accused has the accusers face to face and receives an opportunity of defense concerning the charge.

17 When therefore they came together here, having made no delay, on the next day, having sat upon the judgment seat, I commanded the man to be brought,

18 concerning whom the accusers, having stood, were bringing no accusation of the things which I was supposing,

19 but had some questions against him concerning their own reverence toward divinities and concerning a certain Jesus who had died, whom Paul was asserting to live.

20 And I, being perplexed concerning the inquiry about this, was saying whether he would wish to go to Jerusalem and there be judged concerning these things.

21 But when Paul appealed that he be kept for the determination of the Augustus, I commanded him to be kept until I send him to Caesar.

22 And Agrippa said to Festus, I myself also would wish to hear the person. And he says, Tomorrow you will hear him.

23 On the next day therefore, when Agrippa and Bernice came with much display and entered into the hearing hall with both the commanders of thousands and the prominent men of the city, and when Festus commanded, Paul was brought.

24 And Festus says, King Agrippa and all the men present with us, you behold this man, concerning whom all the multitude of the Jews petitioned me both in Jerusalem and here, shouting that he must no longer live.

25 But I, having perceived that he has done nothing worthy of death, and this man himself also having appealed to the Augustus, decided to send him.

26 Concerning whom I have nothing certain to write to the lord, because of which I brought him forward before you, and especially before you, King Agrippa, so that when the examination has occurred, I may have something to write.

27 For it seems unreasonable to me, sending a prisoner, not also to signify the accusations against him.

Chapter 26

1 And Agrippa said to Paul, You are permitted to speak for yourself. Then Paul was defending himself, having stretched out the hand.

2 Concerning all things of which I am accused by Jews, King Agrippa, I consider myself blessed, being about to defend myself before you today,

3 especially you being a knower of all the customs and questions among Jews, because of which I plead with you to hear me patiently.

4 My manner of life therefore indeed from youth, which occurred from the beginning among my nation in Jerusalem, all the Jews know,

5 knowing me beforehand from the start, if they wish to testify, that according to the most exact sect of our religion I lived a Pharisee.

6 And now upon hope of the promise made to the fathers by God I stand being judged,

7 to which our twelve-tribe people, worshiping in earnestness night and day, hopes to attain. Concerning which hope I am accused, King Agrippa, by the Jews.

8 Why is it judged incredible among you if God raises the dead?

9 I therefore indeed supposed to myself that I must do many opposing things against the name of Jesus the Nazarene,

10 which I also did in Jerusalem, and I shut up many of the saints in prisons, having received authority from the chief priests, and when they were being killed, I cast a vote.

11 And throughout all the synagogues, often punishing them, I was compelling them to blaspheme, and being exceedingly mad against them, was persecuting as far as even the outside cities.

12 In which things also, going to Damascus with authority and commission from the chief priests,

13 at midday along the road I saw, king, a light from heaven beyond the brightness of the sun, shining around me and those going with me.

14 And when we all fell down to the earth, I heard a voice speaking to me and saying in the Hebrew dialect, Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me? It is hard for you to kick against goads.

15 And I said, Who are you, Lord? And he said, I am Jesus whom you persecute.

16 But rise and stand upon your feet, for I appeared to you for this, to appoint you an attendant and witness both of the things which you saw and of the things in which I will appear to you,

17 delivering you from the people and the nations, to whom I now send you,

18 to open their eyes, for them to turn from darkness into light and from the authority of Satan to God, for them to receive forgiveness of sins and a lot among those sanctified by faith in me.

19 Because of which, King Agrippa, I did not become disobedient to the heavenly vision,

20 but to those in Damascus first, and Jerusalem, and into all the country of Judea, and to the nations, announcing to repent and turn to God, doing works worthy of repentance.

21 Because of these things the Jews, having seized me in the temple, were trying to kill me.

22 Having therefore obtained assistance from God, until this day I stand, testifying to both small and great, saying nothing outside the things which both the prophets and Moses spoke as about to happen,

23 whether the Christ is subject to suffering, whether first from resurrection of the dead he is about to proclaim light to the people and to the nations.

24 And while he was defending these things, Festus said with a loud voice, You are mad, Paul; the many writings turn you into madness.

25 But he says, I am not mad, most excellent Festus, but utter sayings of truth and soundness of mind.

26 For the king knows concerning these things, to whom also I speak openly, for I am persuaded that none of these things escapes him, for this has not been done in a corner.

27 Do you believe the prophets, King Agrippa? I know that you believe.

28 But Agrippa said to Paul, In a little you persuade me to become a Christian.

29 And Paul said, I would pray to God, both in a little and in much, that not only you, but also all those hearing me today become such as I also am, except these bonds.

30 And when he said these things, the king rose, and the governor, and Bernice and those sitting with them.

31 And having withdrawn, they were speaking to each other, saying that this person does nothing worthy of death or bonds.

32 And Agrippa said to Festus, This person could have been released if he had not appealed to Caesar.

Chapter 27

1 And when it was decided that we sail away into Italy, they were handing over both Paul and some other prisoners to a centurion named Julius, of the Augustan cohort.

2 And having embarked in an Adramyttian boat, about to sail to the places throughout Asia, we put out, Aristarchus, a Macedonian of Thessalonica, being with us.

3 And on the next day we landed at Sidon, and Julius, having treated Paul humanely, permitted him to go to friends and obtain care.

4 And having put out from there, we sailed under the lee of Cyprus, because the winds were contrary.

5 And having sailed through the open sea along Cilicia and Pamphylia, we came down to Myra of Lycia.

6 And there the centurion, having found an Alexandrian boat sailing to Italy, put us into it.

7 And sailing slowly for considerable days and having scarcely come along Cnidus, the wind not allowing us forward, we sailed under the lee of Crete along Salmone.

8 And scarcely sailing along it, we came into a certain place called Fair Havens, near which was the city Lasaea.

9 And considerable time having elapsed, and the voyage being already dangerous because the fast also had already passed, Paul was advising,

10 saying to them, Men, I behold that the voyage is about to be with violence and much loss, not only of the cargo and the boat, but also of our lives.

11 But the centurion was being persuaded by the pilot and the shipowner rather than by the things said by Paul.

12 And the harbor being unsuitable for wintering, most took counsel to put out from there also, if somehow they might be able, having arrived at Phoenix, to winter, a harbor of Crete looking toward southwest and toward northwest.

13 And a south wind having blown gently, having supposed they had secured the purpose, having weighed anchor, they were sailing close along Crete.

14 But after not much time a typhonic wind called Euroclydon struck down from it.

15 And the boat having been seized and not being able to face the wind, having yielded, we were being carried along.

16 And having run under the lee of a certain little island called Clauda, we were scarcely strong enough to gain control of the small boat,

17 which, having raised, they were using helps, undergirding the boat, and fearing lest they fall into the Syrtis, having lowered the gear, thus they were being carried along.

18 And as we were being severely storm-tossed, on the next day they were making a jettison,

19 and on the third day with our own hands we threw the equipment of the boat.

20 And neither sun nor stars appearing for many days, and no little storm pressing, henceforth all hope of our being saved was being taken away.

21 And much abstinence from food existing, then Paul, having stood in their midst, said, You indeed ought, O men, having obeyed me, not to have put out from Crete, and to have avoided this violence and loss.

22 And now I advise you to be cheerful, for there will be no loss of life from you, except of the boat.

23 For there stood by me this night an angel of God, whose I am, whom I also worship,

24 saying, Do not fear, Paul; you must stand before Caesar, and look, God has granted you all those sailing with you.

25 Because of this be cheerful, men, for I believe God that it will be thus, in the manner it has been spoken to me.

26 But we must fall upon a certain island.

27 And when the fourteenth night came, as we were being driven about in the Adriatic, about the middle of the night the sailors were supposing that some land was approaching them.

28 And having sounded, they found twenty fathoms, and having gone a little farther and having sounded again, they found fifteen fathoms.

29 And fearing lest somehow they fall upon rough places, having thrown four anchors from the stern, they were praying for day to come.

30 And as the sailors were seeking to flee from the boat and had lowered the small boat into the sea under a pretext as though about to stretch out anchors from the bow,

31 Paul said to the centurion and the soldiers, Unless these remain in the boat, you cannot be saved.

32 Then the soldiers cut off the ropes of the small boat and allowed it to fall away.

33 And until day was about to come, Paul was exhorting all to partake of food, saying, Today, the fourteenth day, expecting, you continue without food, having taken nothing.

34 Because of this I exhort you to take food, for this is for your salvation, for a hair from the head of none of you will fall.

35 And having said these things and having taken bread, he gave thanks to God before all, and having broken it, began to eat.

36 And all, having become cheerful, themselves also took food.

37 And we were in the boat, all the souls, two hundred seventy-six.

38 And having been satisfied with food, they were lightening the boat, casting out the wheat into the sea.

39 And when day came, they were not recognizing the land, but were observing a certain bay having a shore, into which they took counsel, if they could, to drive the boat.

40 And having taken off the anchors, they were leaving them in the sea, at the same time having loosed the lashings of the rudders, and having raised the foresail to the blowing wind, were making toward the shore.

41 But having fallen upon a place between two seas, they grounded the ship, and the bow, having stuck fast, remained unshaken, but the stern was being broken up by the violence of the waves.

42 And the soldiers' counsel was to kill the prisoners, lest anyone, having swum out, escape.

43 But the centurion, wishing to save Paul, hindered them from the purpose, and commanded those able to swim, having thrown themselves out first, to go out upon the land,

44 and the rest, some upon boards, but others upon some of the things from the boat. And thus it happened that all were brought safely upon the land.

Chapter 28

1 And having been brought safely, then they learned that the island is called Melite.

2 And the barbarians were providing no ordinary humanity to us, for having kindled a fire, they received us all because of the rain that had come and because of the cold.

3 And when Paul gathered a multitude of sticks and placed them upon the fire, a viper, having come out from the heat, fastened upon his hand.

4 And when the barbarians saw the beast hanging from his hand, they were saying to each other, By all means this person is a murderer, whom, having been brought safely from the sea, Justice did not allow to live.

5 He therefore indeed, having shaken off the beast into the fire, suffered no evil.

6 But they were expecting that he was about to swell or fall down suddenly dead. And when they were expecting for a long time and beholding nothing improper occurring to him, having changed, they were saying that he is a god.

7 And around that place there were properties belonging to the foremost of the island, named Publius, who, having received us, lodged us kindly three days.

8 And it happened that the father of Publius was lying down, held by fevers and dysentery, to whom Paul, having entered and having prayed, having laid hands upon him, healed him.

9 When therefore this happened, the rest also having sicknesses on the island were approaching and being healed,

10 who also honored us with many honors, and when we were putting out, supplied the things for the need.

11 And after three months we put out in an Alexandrian boat that had wintered on the island, with the Dioscuri as its sign.

12 And having landed at Syracuse, we remained three days,

13 from where, having gone around, we arrived at Rhegium, and after one day, a south wind having arisen, on the second day we came to Puteoli,

14 where, having found brothers, we were invited to remain with them seven days, and thus we came to Rome.

15 And from there the brothers, having heard the things concerning us, came out to meet us as far as Appius Forum and Three Taverns, whom Paul, having seen and having given thanks to God, took courage.

16 And when we came to Rome, the centurion handed the prisoners over to the commander of the camp, but Paul was permitted to remain by himself with the soldier guarding him.

17 And it happened after three days that Paul called together the foremost of the Jews, and when they came together, he was saying to them, Men, brothers, I, having done nothing contrary to the people or the ancestral customs, was handed over as a prisoner from Jerusalem into the hands of the Romans,

18 who, having examined me, wished to release me, because no cause of death existed in me.

19 But when the Jews were contradicting, I was compelled to appeal to Caesar, not as having anything to accuse my nation of.

20 Because of this reason therefore I called for you to see and speak with you, for because of the hope of Israel I wear this chain.

21 And they said to him, We neither received letters concerning you from Judea, nor did any of the brothers, having come, report or speak anything wicked concerning you.

22 But we consider it fitting to hear from you the things which you think, for concerning this sect indeed it is known to us that everywhere it is spoken against.

23 And having appointed a day for him, more came to him into the lodging, to whom he was setting it out, solemnly testifying to the kingdom of God and persuading them of the things concerning Jesus from both the law of Moses and the prophets, from morning until evening.

24 And some were being persuaded by the things said, but others were disbelieving.

25 And being in disagreement with each other, they were departing, Paul having said one saying, that the Holy Spirit spoke well through Isaiah the prophet to our fathers,

26 saying, Go to this people and say, With hearing you will hear and certainly not understand, and looking you will look and certainly not see.

27 For the heart of this people was thickened, and with the ears they heard heavily, and they closed their eyes, lest they see with the eyes and hear with the ears and understand with the heart and turn back, and I may heal them.

28 Let it therefore be known to you that the salvation of God was sent to the nations; they also will hear.

29 And when he said these things, the Jews went away, having much dispute among themselves.

30 And Paul remained a whole two years in his own rented dwelling, and was receiving all those entering to him,

31 proclaiming the kingdom of God and teaching the things concerning the Lord Jesus Christ
with all openness, unhindered.

Romans

Chapter 1

1 Paul, a slave of Jesus Christ, a called apostle, set apart for God's gospel,

2 which he promised beforehand through his prophets in holy writings,

3 concerning his Son, who came from David's seed according to flesh,

4 who was designated Son of God in power according to the spirit of holiness by resurrection of the dead, Jesus Christ our Lord,

5 through whom we received grace and apostleship for obedience of faith among all the nations for his name,

6 among whom you too are called of Jesus Christ,

7 to all who are in Rome, beloved of God, called saints: grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

8 First, I thank my God through Jesus Christ for all of you, because your faith is proclaimed in the whole world.

9 For God is my witness, whom I serve in my spirit in the gospel of his Son, how unceasingly I make mention of you,

10 always in my prayers asking whether somehow at last I will be granted a successful journey in God's will to come to you.

11 For I long to see you, that I may share some spiritual gift with you for you to be strengthened,

12 that is, to be encouraged together among you through one another's faith, both yours and mine.

13 But I do not want you to be ignorant, brothers, that I often intended to come to you, and was prevented until now, that I might have some fruit among you too, as among the other nations.

14 I am a debtor both to Greeks and to barbarians, both to the wise and to the senseless.

15 Thus, for my part, I am eager to proclaim the gospel also to you who are in Rome.

16 For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ, for it is God's power for salvation to everyone who believes, to the Jew first and also to the Greek.

17 For in it God's righteousness is revealed from faith to faith, as it is written, “But the righteous one will live by faith.”

18 For God's wrath is revealed from heaven against all ungodliness and unrighteousness of people who suppress the truth in unrighteousness,

19 because what is known of God is manifest among them, for God manifested it to them.

20 For his invisible things, both his eternal power and divinity, are clearly seen from the creation of the world, understood through the things made, so that they are without excuse,

21 because, having known God, they did not glorify him as God or give thanks, but became futile in their reasonings, and their uncomprehending heart was darkened.

22 Claiming to be wise, they became fools,

23 and exchanged the glory of the incorruptible God for a likeness of an image of corruptible man and birds and four-footed animals and reptiles.

24 Therefore God also handed them over, in the desires of their hearts, to impurity, for their bodies to be dishonored among themselves,

25 who exchanged God's truth for the lie, and revered and served the creation rather than the Creator, who is blessed forever. Amen.

26 For this reason God handed them over to passions of dishonor. For even their females exchanged natural use for that contrary to nature,

27 and likewise the males too, leaving the natural use of the female, burned in their desire toward one another, males with males performing the indecency and receiving in themselves the recompense of their error that was due.

28 And as they did not approve of retaining God in knowledge, God handed them over to a disapproved mind, to do things that are not fitting,

29 filled with all unrighteousness, sexual immorality, wickedness, greed, malice; full of envy, murder, strife, deceit, ill will; whisperers,

30 backbiters, God-haters, insolent, arrogant, boastful, inventors of evil things, disobedient to parents,

31 uncomprehending, covenant-breaking, without natural affection, implacable, merciless,

32 who, knowing God's righteous decree that those who practice such things are worthy of death, not only do them but also approve of those who practice them.

Chapter 2

1 Therefore you are without excuse, O man, everyone who judges; for in what you judge the other, you condemn yourself, for you who judge practice the same things.

2 But we know that God's judgment is according to truth against those who practice such things.

3 And do you reckon this, O man, you who judge those who practice such things and do them yourself, that you will escape God's judgment?

4 Or do you despise the riches of his kindness and forbearance and patience, not knowing that God's kindness leads you to repentance?

5 But according to your hardness and unrepentant heart, you store up wrath for yourself on the day of wrath and revelation of God's righteous judgment,

6 who will repay each according to his works:

7 to those who through endurance in good work seek glory and honor and incorruptibility, eternal life;

8 but to those of selfish ambition, who disobey the truth but obey unrighteousness, fury and wrath.

9 Affliction and distress upon every soul of man who works evil, of the Jew first and also of the Greek,

10 but glory and honor and peace to everyone who works good, to the Jew first and also to the Greek.

11 For there is no partiality with God.

12 For as many as sinned without law will also perish without law, and as many as sinned in law will be judged through law.

13 For the hearers of the law are not righteous before God, but the doers of the law will be justified.

14 For whenever nations that do not have law do by nature the things of the law, these, not having law, are a law to themselves,

15 who demonstrate the work of the law written in their hearts, their conscience bearing witness together, and their thoughts among one another accusing or even defending,

16 on the day when God judges people's hidden things, according to my gospel, through Jesus Christ.

17 Look, you are named a Jew, and rest upon the law and boast in God,

18 and know the will and approve the things that differ, being instructed from the law,

19 and are convinced that you yourself are a guide of the blind, a light of those in darkness,

20 an instructor of the foolish, a teacher of infants, having the form of knowledge and truth in the law.

21 You, then, who teach another, do you not teach yourself? You who preach not to steal, do you steal?

22 You who say not to commit adultery, do you commit adultery? You who abhor idols, do you rob temples?

23 You who boast in law, do you dishonor God through transgression of the law?

24 For “God's name is blasphemed among the nations because of you,” as it is written.

25 For circumcision indeed benefits if you practice law; but if you are a transgressor of law, your circumcision has become uncircumcision.

26 Therefore, if the uncircumcision keeps the righteous decrees of the law, will not his uncircumcision be reckoned as circumcision?

27 And the uncircumcision by nature, fulfilling the law, will judge you who, through letter and circumcision, are a transgressor of law.

28 For the one outwardly is not a Jew, nor is the outward circumcision in flesh circumcision,

29 but the one inwardly is a Jew, and circumcision is of the heart, in spirit, not letter, whose praise is not from people but from God.

Chapter 3

1 What, then, is the advantage of the Jew, or what is the benefit of circumcision?

2 Much in every way. For first, they were entrusted with God's oracles.

3 For what if some were unfaithful? Will their unfaithfulness nullify God's faithfulness?

4 May it never be! But let God be true, and every man a liar, as it is written, “So that you may be justified in your words and prevail when you are judged.”

5 But if our unrighteousness demonstrates God's righteousness, what will we say? Is God unrighteous who brings wrath? I speak in human terms.

6 May it never be! Otherwise, how will God judge the world?

7 For if God's truth abounded through my lie to his glory, why am I also still judged as a sinner?

8 And why not, as we are slandered and as some claim we say, “Let us do evil things so that good things may come”? Their judgment is just.

9 What, then? Do we have an advantage? Not at all. For we previously charged both Jews and Greeks with all being under sin,

10 as it is written, “There is no righteous one, not even one;

11 there is no one who understands; there is no one who seeks out God.

12 All turned aside; together they became useless. There is no one who does kindness; there is not even one.

13 Their throat is an opened grave; with their tongues they were deceitful; venom of asps is under their lips,

14 whose mouth is full of curse and bitterness.

15 Their feet are swift to shed blood;

16 devastation and misery are in their ways,

17 and a way of peace they did not know.

18 There is no fear of God before their eyes.”

19 But we know that whatever the law says, it speaks to those in the law, so that every mouth may be stopped and the whole world become accountable to God,

20 because from works of law no flesh will be justified before him; for through law comes knowledge of sin.

21 But now, apart from law, God's righteousness has been manifested, witnessed by the law and the prophets,

22 and God's righteousness through faith of Jesus Christ to all and upon all who believe, for there is no distinction.

23 For all sinned and fall short of God's glory,

24 being justified freely by his grace through the redemption in Christ Jesus,

25 whom God set forth as a propitiatory offering through faith in his blood, for a demonstration of his righteousness because of the passing over of sins previously committed,

26 in God's forbearance, for a demonstration of his righteousness at the present time, so that he may be righteous and justify the one of faith of Jesus.

27 Where, then, is boasting? It was excluded. Through what law? Of works? No, but through a law of faith.

28 We reckon, therefore, that a man is justified by faith apart from works of law.

29 Or is God of Jews only? Is he not also of nations? Yes, of nations also,

30 since God is one, who will justify circumcision from faith and uncircumcision through faith.

31 Do we, then, nullify law through faith? May it never be! Rather, we establish law.

Chapter 4

1 What, then, will we say Abraham our father has found according to flesh?

2 For if Abraham was justified from works, he has a boast, but not before God.

3 For what does the Scripture say? “And Abraham believed God, and it was reckoned to him as righteousness.”

4 But to the one who works, the wage is not reckoned according to grace but according to debt.

5 But to the one who does not work but believes in the one who justifies the ungodly, his faith is reckoned as righteousness,

6 just as David also speaks of the blessedness of the man to whom God reckons righteousness apart from works:

7 “Blessed are those whose lawless deeds were forgiven and whose sins were covered over.

8 Blessed is the man to whom the Lord will certainly not reckon sin.”

9 Is this blessedness, then, upon the circumcision, or also upon the uncircumcision? For we say that faith was reckoned to Abraham as righteousness.

10 How, then, was it reckoned? While he was in circumcision, or in uncircumcision? Not in circumcision, but in uncircumcision.

11 And he received a sign of circumcision, a seal of the righteousness of the faith in uncircumcision, so that he might be father of all who believe through uncircumcision, for righteousness to be reckoned to them too,

12 and father of circumcision to those not of circumcision only, but also to those who walk in the footsteps of the faith of our father Abraham in uncircumcision.

13 For the promise to Abraham or to his seed, that he should be heir of the world, was not through law but through righteousness of faith.

14 For if those of law are heirs, faith has been emptied and the promise nullified.

15 For the law works wrath; for where there is no law, neither is there transgression.

16 For this reason it is from faith, so that it may be according to grace, for the promise to be firm to all the seed, not to that of the law only but also to that of Abraham's faith, who is father of us all,

17 as it is written, “I have made you father of many nations,” before God whom he believed, who gives life to the dead and calls things that are not as things that are,

18 who beyond hope believed upon hope, so that he might become father of many nations, according to what was said, “So will your seed be.”

19 And not becoming weak in faith, he did not consider his own body already dead, being about a hundred years old, and the deadness of Sarah's womb.

20 But concerning God's promise he did not waver in unbelief, but was empowered in faith, giving glory to God,

21 and being fully convinced that what he has promised he is also able to do.

22 Therefore it was also reckoned to him as righteousness.

23 But it was not written for him alone that it was reckoned to him,

24 but also for us, to whom it is to be reckoned, who believe in the one who raised Jesus our Lord from the dead,

25 who was handed over because of our trespasses and was raised because of our justification.

Chapter 5

1 Therefore, having been justified from faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ,

2 through whom we have also obtained access by faith into this grace in which we stand, and we boast upon hope of God's glory.

3 And not only this, but we also boast in afflictions, knowing that affliction works endurance,

4 and endurance proven character, and proven character hope.

5 And hope does not put to shame, because God's love has been poured out in our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us.

6 For while we were still weak, Christ died at the appointed time for the ungodly.

7 For scarcely will someone die for a righteous one; for perhaps someone even dares to die for the good one.

8 But God demonstrates his own love toward us, in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us.

9 Much more, then, having now been justified in his blood, we will be saved through him from wrath.

10 For if, being enemies, we were reconciled to God through the death of his Son, much more, having been reconciled, we will be saved in his life.

11 And not only this, but also boasting in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we now received reconciliation.

12 For this reason, just as through one man sin entered the world, and through sin death, and thus death passed to all people, because all sinned—

13 for until law, sin was in the world, but sin is not charged when there is no law.

14 Nevertheless, death reigned from Adam until Moses, even over those who did not sin in the likeness of Adam's transgression, who is a pattern of the coming one.

15 But the gracious gift is not as the trespass. For if by the trespass of the one the many died, much more God's grace and the gift in the grace of the one man Jesus Christ abounded to the many.

16 And the gift is not as through one who sinned; for the judgment is from one to condemnation, but the gracious gift is from many trespasses to a righteous verdict.

17 For if by the trespass of the one death reigned through the one, much more those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness will reign in life through the one, Jesus Christ.

18 So then, as through one trespass to all people to condemnation, so also through one righteous act to all people to justification of life.

19 For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were constituted sinners, so also through the obedience of the one the many will be constituted righteous.

20 But law entered alongside, so that the trespass might increase; but where sin increased, grace abounded beyond measure,

21 so that just as sin reigned in death, so also grace might reign through righteousness to eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

Chapter 6

1 What, then, will we say? Will we continue in sin so that grace may increase?

2 May it never be! We who died to sin, how will we still live in it?

3 Or do you not know that as many of us as were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death?

4 Therefore we were buried together with him through baptism into death, so that just as Christ was raised from the dead through the Father's glory, so we too might walk in newness of life.

5 For if we have become united with the likeness of his death, we will also be of his resurrection,

6 knowing this, that our old man was crucified together with him, so that the body of sin might be rendered powerless, for us no longer to be slaves to sin.

7 For the one who died has been justified from sin.

8 But if we died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him,

9 knowing that Christ, raised from the dead, no longer dies; death no longer rules over him.

10 For the death he died, he died to sin once for all; but the life he lives, he lives to God.

11 Thus you too reckon yourselves to be dead to sin, but living to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.

12 Therefore do not let sin reign in your mortal body, to obey it in its desires,

13 nor present your members to sin as weapons of unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God as living from the dead, and your members to God as weapons of righteousness.

14 For sin will not rule over you, for you are not under law but under grace.

15 What, then? Will we sin because we are not under law but under grace? May it never be!

16 Do you not know that to whom you present yourselves as slaves for obedience, you are slaves to whom you obey, either of sin to death or of obedience to righteousness?

17 But thanks to God that you were slaves of sin, but obeyed from the heart the pattern of teaching to which you were handed over,

18 and having been freed from sin, you were enslaved to righteousness.

19 I speak in human terms because of the weakness of your flesh. For just as you presented your members as slaves to impurity and to lawlessness unto lawlessness, so now present your members as slaves to righteousness unto sanctification.

20 For when you were slaves of sin, you were free with respect to righteousness.

21 What fruit, then, did you have then in the things of which you are now ashamed? For the end of those things is death.

22 But now, having been freed from sin and enslaved to God, you have your fruit unto sanctification, and the end, eternal life.

23 For the wages of sin are death, but God's gracious gift is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Chapter 7

1 Or do you not know, brothers—for I speak to those who know law—that the law rules over a man for as long a time as he lives?

2 For the married woman is bound by law to the living husband; but if the husband dies, she has been released from the law of the husband.

3 So then, while the husband lives, she will be called an adulteress if she becomes another man's; but if the husband dies, she is free from the law, so that she is not an adulteress when she becomes another man's.

4 So, my brothers, you too were put to death to the law through the body of Christ, for you to become another's, his who was raised from the dead, so that we might bear fruit to God.

5 For when we were in the flesh, the passions of sins, which were through the law, were at work in our members to bear fruit to death.

6 But now we have been released from the law, having died in that in which we were held, so that we serve as slaves in newness of spirit and not in oldness of letter.

7 What, then, will we say? Is the law sin? May it never be! But I did not know sin except through law; for I would not have known desire either unless the law said, “You shall not desire.”

8 But sin, taking an opportunity through the commandment, worked every desire in me. For apart from law, sin is dead.

9 But I was once living apart from law; but when the commandment came, sin came to life again, and I died.

10 And the commandment that was unto life was found for me to be unto death.

11 For sin, taking an opportunity through the commandment, deceived me and through it killed me.

12 So the law is holy, and the commandment holy and righteous and good.

13 Did the good, then, become death to me? May it never be! But sin, so that it might appear as sin, working death for me through the good, so that through the commandment sin might become exceedingly sinful.

14 For we know that the law is spiritual, but I am fleshly, sold under sin.

15 For what I work I do not understand; for I do not practice what I want, but what I hate, this I do.

16 But if what I do not want, this I do, I agree with the law that it is good.

17 But now it is no longer I who work it, but the sin dwelling in me.

18 For I know that good does not dwell in me, that is, in my flesh; for willing is present with me, but working the good I do not find.

19 For I do not do the good I want, but the evil I do not want, this I practice.

20 But if what I do not want, this I do, it is no longer I who work it, but the sin dwelling in me.

21 I find, then, the law that, for me who wants to do the good, evil is present with me.

22 For I delight together with God's law according to the inner man,

23 but I see another law in my members, waging war against the law of my mind and taking me captive to the law of sin that is in my members.

24 Wretched man that I am! Who will rescue me from the body of this death?

25 I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord. So then I myself, with the mind, serve as a slave to God's law, but with the flesh to sin's law.

Chapter 8

1 There is therefore now no condemnation for those in Christ Jesus who walk not according to flesh but according to spirit.

2 For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus freed me from the law of sin and death.

3 For what was impossible for the law, in that it was weak through the flesh, God, sending his own Son in the likeness of flesh of sin and concerning sin, condemned sin in the flesh,

4 so that the righteous requirement of the law might be fulfilled in us, who walk not according to flesh but according to spirit.

5 For those who are according to flesh mind the things of the flesh, but those according to spirit the things of the Spirit.

6 For the mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace,

7 because the mind of the flesh is hostility toward God, for it does not submit to God's law, for neither can it.

8 And those who are in flesh cannot please God.

9 But you are not in flesh but in spirit, if indeed God's Spirit dwells in you. But if someone does not have Christ's Spirit, this one is not his.

10 But if Christ is in you, the body is dead because of sin, but the spirit is life because of righteousness.

11 But if the Spirit of the one who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you, the one who raised Christ from the dead will also give life to your mortal bodies because of his Spirit dwelling in you.

12 So then, brothers, we are debtors, not to the flesh to live according to flesh.

13 For if you live according to flesh, you are about to die; but if by spirit you put to death the practices of the body, you will live.

14 For as many as are led by God's Spirit, these are sons of God.

15 For you did not receive a spirit of slavery again unto fear, but you received a spirit of adoption as sons, in which we cry, “Abba, Father.”

16 The Spirit himself bears witness together with our spirit that we are children of God.

17 And if children, also heirs: heirs of God and fellow heirs of Christ, if indeed we suffer together so that we may also be glorified together.

18 For I reckon that the sufferings of the present time are not worthy in comparison with the coming glory to be revealed to us.

19 For the eager expectation of creation awaits the revelation of the sons of God.

20 For creation was subjected to futility, not willingly, but because of the one who subjected it, upon hope

21 that creation itself too will be freed from the slavery of corruption into the freedom of the glory of God's children.

22 For we know that all creation groans together and suffers birth pains together until now.

23 And not only this, but we ourselves too, having the firstfruits of the Spirit, also groan within ourselves, awaiting adoption as sons, the redemption of our body.

24 For in hope we were saved; but hope that is seen is not hope, for what someone sees, why does he also hope for it?

25 But if we hope for what we do not see, we await it through endurance.

26 And likewise the Spirit also helps with our weaknesses; for we do not know what to pray as we ought, but the Spirit himself intercedes for us with unutterable groanings.

27 And the one who searches the hearts knows what the mind of the Spirit is, because he intercedes for saints according to God.

28 And we know that all things work together for good for those who love God, for those who are called according to purpose,

29 because those whom he foreknew he also predestined to be conformed to the image of his Son, so that he might be firstborn among many brothers.

30 And those whom he predestined, these he also called; and those whom he called, these he also justified; and those whom he justified, these he also glorified.

31 What, then, will we say to these things? If God is for us, who is against us?

32 He who indeed did not spare his own Son but handed him over for us all, how will he not also with him freely give us all things?

33 Who will bring a charge against God's chosen ones? God is the one who justifies.

34 Who is the one who condemns? Christ is the one who died, and rather also was raised, who also is at God's right hand, who also intercedes for us.

35 Who will separate us from Christ's love? Affliction or distress or persecution or famine or nakedness or danger or sword?

36 As it is written, “For your sake we are put to death all the day; we were reckoned as sheep for slaughter.”

37 But in all these things we more than conquer through the one who loved us.

38 For I am convinced that neither death nor life nor angels nor rulers nor powers nor present things nor coming things,

39 nor height nor depth nor any other creation will be able to separate us from God's love in Christ Jesus our Lord.

Chapter 9

1 I speak truth in Christ, I do not lie, my conscience bearing witness together with me in the Holy Spirit,

2 that I have great grief and unceasing pain in my heart.

3 For I could wish that I myself were accursed away from Christ for my brothers, my kinsmen according to flesh,

4 who are Israelites, whose are the adoption as sons and the glory and the covenants and the giving of the law and the service and the promises,

5 whose are the fathers, and from whom is Christ according to flesh, who is over all, God blessed forever. Amen.

6 But it is not as though God's word has fallen away. For not all those from Israel are Israel,

7 nor, because they are Abraham's seed, are they all children, but “In Isaac seed will be called for you.”

8 That is, the children of the flesh are not the children of God, but the children of the promise are reckoned as seed.

9 For this is the word of promise: “At this time I will come, and Sarah will have a son.”

10 And not only this, but also Rebecca, having conceived by one, Isaac our father—

11 for before they had been born or done anything good or evil, so that God's purpose according to choice might remain, not from works but from the one who calls—

12 it was said to her, “The greater will serve as a slave to the lesser,”

13 as it is written, “Jacob I loved, but Esau I hated.”

14 What, then, will we say? Is there unrighteousness with God? May it never be!

15 For he says to Moses, “I will have mercy on whomever I have mercy, and I will have compassion on whomever I have compassion.”

16 So then it is not of the one who wills, nor of the one who runs, but of God who has mercy.

17 For the Scripture says to Pharaoh, “For this very thing I raised you up, that I might demonstrate my power in you, and that my name might be proclaimed in all the earth.”

18 So then he has mercy on whom he wills, and he hardens whom he wills.

19 You will say to me, then, “Why does he still find fault? For who has resisted his will?”

20 Indeed, O man, who are you who answers back to God? Will the thing formed say to the one who formed it, “Why did you make me thus?”

21 Or does the potter not have authority over the clay, to make from the same lump one vessel for honor and another for dishonor?

22 But if God, willing to demonstrate wrath and make known his power, bore with much patience vessels of wrath fitted for destruction,

23 and so that he might make known the riches of his glory upon vessels of mercy, which he prepared beforehand for glory,

24 whom he also called, us, not only from Jews but also from nations?

25 As he also says in Hosea, “I will call the one not my people my people, and the one not beloved beloved.

26 And it will be in the place where it was said to them, ‘You are not my people,’ there they will be called sons of the living God.”

27 And Isaiah cries out concerning Israel, “If the number of Israel's sons is as the sand of the sea, the remnant will be saved.

28 For he completes and cuts short a word in righteousness, because the Lord will make a shortened word upon the earth.”

29 And as Isaiah has said beforehand, “Unless the Lord Sabaoth had left us seed, we would have become as Sodom and would have been made like Gomorrah.”

30 What, then, will we say? That nations that did not pursue righteousness attained righteousness, and righteousness from faith,

31 but Israel, pursuing a law of righteousness, did not reach a law of righteousness.

32 Why? Because not from faith, but as from works of law. For they stumbled against the stone of stumbling,

33 as it is written, “Look, I place in Zion a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense, and everyone who believes upon him will not be put to shame.”

Chapter 10

1 Brothers, the good pleasure of my heart and my petition to God for Israel are for salvation.

2 For I bear witness to them that they have zeal for God, but not according to knowledge.

3 For, not knowing God's righteousness and seeking to establish their own righteousness, they did not submit to God's righteousness.

4 For Christ is the end of law unto righteousness for everyone who believes.

5 For Moses writes the righteousness from the law, that “The man who does them will live in them.”

6 But the righteousness from faith speaks thus: “Do not say in your heart, ‘Who will ascend into heaven?’” That is, to bring Christ down.

7 Or, “‘Who will descend into the abyss?’” That is, to bring Christ up from the dead.

8 But what does it say? “The word is near you, in your mouth and in your heart.” That is, the word of faith which we preach,

9 that if you confess with your mouth Jesus as Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved.

10 For with the heart one believes unto righteousness, and with the mouth one confesses unto salvation.

11 For the Scripture says, “Everyone who believes upon him will not be put to shame.”

12 For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek, for the same Lord of all is rich toward all who call upon him.

13 For “Everyone who calls upon the Lord's name will be saved.”

14 How, then, will they call upon one in whom they did not believe? And how will they believe one whom they did not hear? And how will they hear without one who preaches?

15 And how will they preach unless they are sent? As it is written, “How beautiful are the feet of those who proclaim peace, of those who proclaim good things.”

16 But not all obeyed the gospel. For Isaiah says, “Lord, who believed our report?”

17 So faith is from hearing, and hearing through God's word.

18 But I say, did they not hear? Indeed, “Their sound went out into all the earth, and their words to the ends of the inhabited world.”

19 But I say, did Israel not know? First Moses says, “I will provoke you to jealousy over a non-nation; over an uncomprehending nation I will provoke you to anger.”

20 And Isaiah is very bold and says, “I was found by those who did not seek me; I became manifest to those who did not ask for me.”

21 But to Israel he says, “All the day I stretched out my hands to a disobedient and contradicting people.”

Chapter 11

1 I say, then, did God reject his people? May it never be! For I too am an Israelite, from Abraham's seed, of Benjamin's tribe.

2 God did not reject his people whom he foreknew. Or do you not know what the Scripture says in Elijah, how he appeals to God against Israel, saying,

3 “Lord, they killed your prophets and tore down your altars, and I alone was left, and they seek my life”?

4 But what does the divine response say to him? “I left for myself seven thousand men who did not bend a knee to Baal.”

5 Thus, then, also at the present time a remnant has come to be according to a choice of grace.

6 But if by grace, no longer from works, otherwise grace no longer becomes grace. But if from works, it is no longer grace, otherwise work is no longer work.

7 What, then? What Israel seeks, this it did not obtain, but the chosen obtained it, and the rest were hardened,

8 as it is written, “God gave them a spirit of stupor, eyes not to see and ears not to hear, until this very day.”

9 And David says, “Let their table become a snare and a trap and an offense and a recompense to them.

10 Let their eyes be darkened so as not to see, and bend their back continually.”

11 I say, then, did they stumble so that they might fall? May it never be! But by their trespass salvation is for the nations, to provoke them to jealousy.

12 But if their trespass is riches of the world, and their loss riches of nations, how much more their fullness!

13 For I speak to you, the nations. Insofar as I am an apostle of nations, I glorify my ministry,

14 if somehow I may provoke my flesh to jealousy and save some of them.

15 For if their rejection is reconciliation of the world, what is the acceptance except life from the dead?

16 And if the firstfruits are holy, so is the lump; and if the root is holy, so are the branches.

17 But if some of the branches were broken off, and you, being a wild olive, were grafted in among them and became a fellow sharer of the root and richness of the olive,

18 do not boast against the branches. But if you boast against them, you do not carry the root, but the root you.

19 You will say, then, “The branches were broken off so that I might be grafted in.”

20 Well, they were broken off through unbelief, but you stand by faith. Do not be high-minded, but fear.

21 For if God did not spare the branches according to nature, beware lest he not spare you either.

22 See, then, God's kindness and severity: severity upon those who fell, but kindness upon you, if you remain in the kindness; otherwise you too will be cut off.

23 And they too, if they do not remain in unbelief, will be grafted in; for God is able to graft them in again.

24 For if you were cut off from the olive wild by nature and were grafted contrary to nature into a cultivated olive, how much more will these, who are according to nature, be grafted into their own olive!

25 For I do not want you to be ignorant, brothers, of this mystery, so that you may not be wise in your own estimation, that a hardening in part has come to Israel until the fullness of the nations enters,

26 and thus all Israel will be saved, as it is written, “The rescuer will come from Zion, and will turn away ungodliness from Jacob.

27 And this is the covenant from me for them, when I take away their sins.”

28 According to the gospel, enemies for your sake, but according to the choice, beloved because of the fathers.

29 For God's gracious gifts and calling are without regret.

30 For just as you too once disobeyed God, but now received mercy through their disobedience,

31 so these too now disobeyed, so that through the mercy to you they too might receive mercy.

32 For God shut up all in disobedience so that he might have mercy on all.

33 O depth of riches and wisdom and knowledge of God! How unsearchable his judgments and untraceable his ways!

34 For who knew the Lord's mind? Or who became his counselor?

35 Or who gave to him beforehand, and it will be repaid to him?

36 Because from him and through him and to him are all things. To him the glory forever. Amen.

Chapter 12

1 Therefore I urge you, brothers, through God's compassions, to present your bodies as a living sacrifice, holy, pleasing to God, your rational service.

2 And do not be conformed to this age, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind, for you to discern what God's will is, the good and pleasing and perfect.

3 For through the grace given to me I say to everyone among you not to think more highly than he ought to think, but to think so as to think soundly, to each as God apportioned a measure of faith.

4 For just as in one body we have many members, but all the members do not have the same function,

5 so we, the many, are one body in Christ, and individually members of one another.

6 And having gracious gifts differing according to the grace given to us, whether prophecy, according to the proportion of faith,

7 or ministry, in ministry; or the one who teaches, in teaching;

8 or the one who encourages, in encouragement; the one who shares, in simplicity; the one who leads, in diligence; the one who shows mercy, in cheerfulness.

9 Love without hypocrisy; abhorring the evil, clinging to the good;

10 in brotherly love, affectionately devoted to one another; in honor, taking the lead toward one another;

11 in diligence, not sluggish; boiling in spirit; serving the time;

12 rejoicing in hope; enduring in affliction; persevering in prayer;

13 sharing in the needs of the saints; pursuing hospitality.

14 Bless those who persecute you; bless and do not curse.

15 Rejoice with those who rejoice, and weep with those who weep.

16 Thinking the same toward one another; not thinking high things, but being carried along with the lowly. Do not become wise in your own estimation.

17 Repaying no one evil for evil; taking forethought for good things before all people;

18 if possible, as far as it depends on you, being at peace with all people.

19 Not avenging yourselves, beloved, but give place to wrath; for it is written, “Vengeance is mine; I will repay, says the Lord.”

20 Therefore, if your enemy is hungry, feed him; if he is thirsty, give him drink; for doing this you will heap coals of fire upon his head.

21 Do not be conquered by evil, but conquer evil with good.

Chapter 13

1 Let every soul submit to the higher authorities. For there is no authority except from God, and the authorities that exist have been appointed by God.

2 So the one who opposes the authority has resisted God's ordinance, and those who have resisted will receive judgment for themselves.

3 For rulers are not a fear to good works but to evil ones. And do you want not to fear the authority? Do the good, and you will have praise from it.

4 For it is God's minister to you for good. But if you do the evil, fear; for it does not bear the sword in vain, for it is God's minister, an avenger unto wrath upon the one who practices evil.

5 Therefore it is necessary to submit, not only because of wrath but also because of conscience.

6 For because of this you also pay taxes; for they are God's public servants, persevering in this very thing.

7 Therefore repay all their dues: to the one due tax, tax; to the one due toll, toll; to the one due fear, fear; to the one due honor, honor.

8 Owe no one anything except to love one another, for the one who loves the other has fulfilled law.

9 For “You shall not commit adultery, you shall not murder, you shall not steal, you shall not bear false witness, you shall not desire,” and if there is any other commandment, it is summed up in this word, in “You shall love your neighbor as yourself.”

10 Love does not work evil to the neighbor; therefore love is the fulfillment of law.

11 And this, knowing the time, that it is already the hour for us to be raised from sleep; for now our salvation is nearer than when we believed.

12 The night advanced, and the day has drawn near. Therefore let us put off the works of darkness and put on the weapons of light.

13 Let us walk decently, as in day, not in revelries and drunkenness, not in sexual beds and licentious acts, not in strife and jealousy.

14 But put on the Lord Jesus Christ, and do not make provision for the flesh unto desires.

Chapter 14

1 But receive the one who is weak in faith, not for disputes over reasonings.

2 One believes he may eat all things, but the weak one eats vegetables.

3 Let the one who eats not despise the one who does not eat, and let the one who does not eat not judge the one who eats, for God received him.

4 Who are you who judges another's household servant? To his own lord he stands or falls. And he will be made to stand, for God is able to make him stand.

5 One judges a day above a day, but another judges every day. Let each be fully convinced in his own mind.

6 The one who regards the day regards it to the Lord, and the one who does not regard the day does not regard it to the Lord. The one who eats eats to the Lord, for he gives thanks to God; and the one who does not eat does not eat to the Lord and gives thanks to God.

7 For none of us lives to himself, and none dies to himself.

8 For if we live, we live to the Lord, and if we die, we die to the Lord. Therefore, whether we live or whether we die, we are the Lord's.

9 For to this end Christ both died and rose and lived again, so that he might rule over both dead and living.

10 But why do you judge your brother? Or why do you also despise your brother? For we will all stand before Christ's judgment seat.

11 For it is written, “I live, says the Lord, that to me every knee will bend, and every tongue will confess to God.”

12 So then each of us will give an account concerning himself to God.

13 Therefore let us no longer judge one another, but rather judge this: not to place a stumbling block or an offense for the brother.

14 I know and am convinced in the Lord Jesus that nothing is common through itself, except that to the one who reckons something to be common, to that one it is common.

15 But if your brother is grieved because of food, you no longer walk according to love. Do not destroy with your food that one for whom Christ died.

16 Therefore do not let your good be blasphemed.

17 For God's kingdom is not eating and drinking, but righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit.

18 For the one who in these things serves as a slave to Christ is pleasing to God and approved by people.

19 So then let us pursue the things of peace and the things of building up one another.

20 Do not tear down God's work for the sake of food. All things indeed are clean, but it is evil for the man who eats through a stumbling block.

21 It is good not to eat meat or drink wine or anything by which your brother stumbles or is offended or is weakened.

22 Do you have faith? Have it to yourself before God. Blessed is the one who does not judge himself in what he approves.

23 But the one who doubts, if he eats, has been condemned, because it is not from faith; and everything that is not from faith is sin.

Chapter 15

1 But we who are strong ought to carry the weaknesses of those who are not strong, and not please ourselves.

2 For let each of us please the neighbor for good, toward building up.

3 For Christ too did not please himself, but as it is written, “The reproaches of those who reproach you fell upon me.”

4 For whatever was written beforehand was written beforehand for our teaching, so that through endurance and through the encouragement of the writings we might have hope.

5 And may the God of endurance and encouragement grant you to think the same among one another according to Christ Jesus,

6 so that with one accord, with one mouth, you may glorify the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ.

7 Therefore receive one another, just as Christ also received us, unto God's glory.

8 And I say that Jesus Christ has become a minister of circumcision for God's truth, to confirm the promises of the fathers,

9 and for the nations to glorify God for mercy, as it is written, “For this reason I will confess to you among nations and sing to your name.”

10 And again he says, “Rejoice, nations, with his people.”

11 And again, “Praise the Lord, all the nations, and praise him, all the peoples.”

12 And again Isaiah says, “There will be the root of Jesse, and the one who rises to rule nations; upon him nations will hope.”

13 And may the God of hope fill you with all joy and peace in believing, for you to abound in hope in the power of the Holy Spirit.

14 And I myself too am convinced concerning you, my brothers, that you yourselves too are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish one another.

15 But I wrote to you more boldly in part, brothers, as reminding you again, because of the grace given to me by God,

16 for me to be a public minister of Jesus Christ to the nations, performing priestly service for God's gospel, so that the offering of the nations might become acceptable, sanctified in the Holy Spirit.

17 Therefore I have boasting in Christ Jesus in the things toward God.

18 For I will not dare to speak of anything that Christ did not work through me for obedience of nations, in word and deed,

19 in power of signs and wonders, in power of God's Spirit, so that from Jerusalem and around as far as Illyricum I have fulfilled Christ's gospel,

20 and thus aspiring to proclaim the gospel where Christ had not been named, so that I might not build upon another's foundation,

21 but as it is written, “Those to whom it was not announced concerning him will see, and those who have not heard will understand.”

22 Therefore I was also hindered many times from coming to you.

23 But now, no longer having a place in these regions, and having a longing to come to you for many years,

24 whenever I travel to Spain, I will come to you. For I hope, passing through, to see you and to be sent on there by you, if first I am in part filled with you.

25 But now I travel to Jerusalem, ministering to the saints.

26 For Macedonia and Achaia were pleased to make a contribution for the poor among the saints in Jerusalem.

27 For they were pleased, and they are their debtors. For if the nations shared in their spiritual things, they ought also to serve them in fleshly things.

28 Therefore, having completed this and sealed this fruit to them, I will go away through you to Spain.

29 And I know that when I come to you, I will come in the fullness of the blessing of Christ's gospel.

30 And I urge you, brothers, through our Lord Jesus Christ and through the love of the Spirit, to strive together with me in prayers for me to God,

31 so that I may be rescued from those who disobey in Judea, and so that my ministry to Jerusalem may become acceptable to the saints,

32 so that I may come to you in joy through God's will and find rest together with you.

33 And the God of peace be with you all. Amen.

Chapter 16

1 And I commend to you Phoebe our sister, who is a minister of the church in Cenchreae,

2 so that you may receive her in the Lord worthily of the saints, and stand by her in whatever matter she may need you; for she herself also became a patron of many and of me myself.

3 Greet Priscilla and Aquila, my fellow workers in Christ Jesus,

4 who laid down their own neck for my life, to whom not only I give thanks, but also all the churches of the nations,

5 and the church in their house. Greet Epaenetus my beloved, who is the firstfruits of Achaia unto Christ.

6 Greet Mariam, who labored much for us.

7 Greet Andronicus and Junia, my kinsmen and fellow captives, who are notable among the apostles, who also have been in Christ before me.

8 Greet Amplias, my beloved in the Lord.

9 Greet Urbanus, our fellow worker in Christ, and Stachys my beloved.

10 Greet Apelles, the approved one in Christ. Greet those of Aristobulus.

11 Greet Herodion my kinsman. Greet those of Narcissus who are in the Lord.

12 Greet Tryphaena and Tryphosa, who labor in the Lord. Greet Persis the beloved, who labored much in the Lord.

13 Greet Rufus, the chosen one in the Lord, and his mother and mine.

14 Greet Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermas, Patrobas, Hermes, and the brothers with them.

15 Greet Philologus and Julia, Nereus and his sister, and Olympas, and all the saints with them.

16 Greet one another with a holy kiss. The churches of Christ greet you.

17 And I urge you, brothers, to watch those who make divisions and offenses contrary to the teaching you learned, and turn away from them.

18 For such people do not serve as slaves to our Lord Jesus Christ, but to their own belly, and through smooth speech and flattering speech deceive the hearts of the innocent.

19 For your obedience reached all. Therefore I rejoice over you, but I want you to be wise toward good and unmixed toward evil.

20 And the God of peace will crush Satan under your feet shortly. The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

21 Timothy my fellow worker greets you, and Lucius and Jason and Sosipater, my kinsmen.

22 I, Tertius, who wrote the letter, greet you in the Lord.

23 Gaius, my host and that of the whole church, greets you. Erastus, the city's steward, greets you, and Quartus the brother.

24 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

25 And to the one who is able to strengthen you according to my gospel and the proclamation of Jesus Christ, according to revelation of a mystery kept silent in eternal times,

26 but now manifested, and through prophetic writings, according to the command of the eternal God, made known to all the nations for obedience of faith,

27 to the only wise God, through Jesus Christ, to whom be the glory forever. Amen.

1 Corinthians

Chapter 1

1 Paul, a called apostle of Jesus Christ through God's will, and Sosthenes the brother,

2 to God's church in Corinth, sanctified in Christ Jesus, called saints, with all who call upon the name of our Lord Jesus Christ in every place, both theirs and ours:

3 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

4 I thank my God always concerning you for God's grace given to you in Christ Jesus,

5 that in everything you were enriched in him, in every word and all knowledge,

6 just as Christ's testimony was confirmed among you,

7 so that you lack no gracious gift, awaiting the revelation of our Lord Jesus Christ,

8 who will also confirm you until the end, unaccused on the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.

9 God is faithful, through whom you were called into fellowship of his Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

10 But I urge you, brothers, through the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that you all say the same thing and that there be no divisions among you, but that you be fitted together in the same mind and the same judgment.

11 For it was made clear to me concerning you, my brothers, by those of Chloe, that there are quarrels among you.

12 And I mean this: each of you says, “I am Paul's,” “I am Apollos's,” “I am Cephas's,” “I am Christ's.”

13 Has Christ been divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Or were you baptized into Paul's name?

14 I thank God that I baptized none of you except Crispus and Gaius,

15 so that no one may say that I baptized into my own name.

16 And I also baptized Stephanas's household; beyond that I do not know whether I baptized anyone else.

17 For Christ did not send me to baptize but to proclaim the gospel, not in wisdom of speech, so that Christ's cross might not be emptied.

18 For the word of the cross is foolishness to those perishing, but to us being saved it is God's power.

19 For it is written, “I will destroy the wisdom of the wise, and reject the understanding of the understanding.”

20 Where is the wise one? Where is the scribe? Where is the debater of this age? Did God not make the wisdom of this world foolish?

21 For since, in God's wisdom, the world did not know God through wisdom, God was pleased through the foolishness of the proclamation to save those who believe.

22 Since Jews also ask for a sign, and Greeks seek wisdom,

23 but we preach Christ crucified, an offense to Jews and foolishness to Greeks,

24 but to the called themselves, both Jews and Greeks, Christ, God's power and God's wisdom.

25 Because God's foolish thing is wiser than people, and God's weak thing is stronger than people.

26 For see your calling, brothers, that not many are wise according to flesh, not many powerful, not many wellborn.

27 But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise, and God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong things,

28 and God chose the lowborn things of the world and the despised things and the things that are not, to nullify the things that are,

29 so that no flesh may boast before him.

30 But from him you are in Christ Jesus, who became for us wisdom from God, and righteousness and sanctification and redemption,

31 so that, as it is written, “Let the one who boasts boast in the Lord.”

Chapter 2

1 And I, coming to you, brothers, did not come with superiority of speech or wisdom, proclaiming God's testimony to you.

2 For I decided not to know anything among you except Jesus Christ, and him crucified.

3 And I was with you in weakness and fear and much trembling.

4 And my speech and my proclamation were not in persuasive words of human wisdom, but in demonstration of spirit and power,

5 so that your faith might not be in people's wisdom but in God's power.

6 But we speak wisdom among the mature, yet wisdom not of this age nor of the rulers of this age who are being nullified,

7 but we speak God's wisdom in a mystery, the hidden wisdom which God predestined before the ages for our glory,

8 which none of the rulers of this age has known; for if they had known, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.

9 But as it is written, “Things an eye did not see and an ear did not hear and that did not rise upon a man's heart, things God prepared for those who love him.”

10 But God revealed them to us through his Spirit; for the Spirit searches everything, even God's depths.

11 For who among people knows a man's things except the man's spirit within him? Thus also no one knows God's things except God's Spirit.

12 But we received not the world's spirit but the Spirit from God, so that we may know the things freely given us by God,

13 which we also speak, not in words taught by human wisdom but in those taught by the Holy Spirit, comparing spiritual things with spiritual things.

14 But a natural man does not receive the things of God's Spirit, for they are foolishness to him, and he cannot know them, because they are examined spiritually.

15 But the spiritual one examines everything, but he himself is examined by no one.

16 For who knew the Lord's mind, who will instruct him? But we have Christ's mind.

Chapter 3

1 And I, brothers, could not speak to you as spiritual people, but as fleshly people, as infants in Christ.

2 I gave you milk to drink and not food, for you were not yet able; but neither are you able even now,

3 for you are still fleshly. For where there are jealousy and strife and divisions among you, are you not fleshly and walking according to man?

4 For whenever someone says, “I am Paul's,” and another, “I am Apollos's,” are you not fleshly?

5 Who, then, is Paul, and who is Apollos, but ministers through whom you believed, and to each as the Lord gave?

6 I planted, Apollos watered, but God gave growth.

7 So neither the one who plants is anything nor the one who waters, but God who gives growth.

8 And the one who plants and the one who waters are one, but each will receive his own wage according to his own labor.

9 For we are God's fellow workers; you are God's cultivated field, God's building.

10 According to God's grace given to me, as a wise master builder I have laid a foundation, but another builds upon it. But let each watch how he builds upon it.

11 For no one can lay another foundation besides the one laid, which is Jesus Christ.

12 But if someone builds upon this foundation gold, silver, precious stones, wood, grass, straw,

13 each one's work will become manifest, for the day will make it clear, because it is revealed in fire, and the fire will test what sort each one's work is.

14 If someone's work which he built upon it remains, he will receive a wage.

15 If someone's work is burned up, he will suffer loss; but he himself will be saved, yet thus as through fire.

16 Do you not know that you are God's temple and God's Spirit dwells in you?

17 If someone destroys God's temple, God will destroy this one; for God's temple is holy, which you are.

18 Let no one deceive himself. If someone among you thinks he is wise in this age, let him become foolish so that he may become wise.

19 For this world's wisdom is foolishness with God. For it is written, “The one who catches the wise in their cunning,”

20 and again, “The Lord knows the reasonings of the wise, that they are futile.”

21 So let no one boast in people, for everything is yours,

22 whether Paul or Apollos or Cephas or world or life or death or present things or coming things; everything is yours,

23 and you are Christ's, and Christ is God's.

Chapter 4

1 Thus let a man reckon us as servants of Christ and stewards of God's mysteries.

2 And furthermore it is sought among stewards that one be found faithful.

3 But to me it is a very small thing that I should be examined by you or by a human day; but neither do I examine myself.

4 For I am conscious of nothing against myself, but I have not been justified by this; and the one who examines me is the Lord.

5 So judge nothing before the time, until the Lord comes, who will both illuminate the hidden things of darkness and manifest the counsels of hearts; and then each one's praise will come from God.

6 And these things, brothers, I transferred in form to myself and Apollos because of you, so that in us you may learn not to think beyond what is written, so that you may not be puffed up, one for the one against the other.

7 For who distinguishes you? And what do you have that you did not receive? And if you also received it, why do you boast as though not having received?

8 Already you are filled, already you became rich, apart from us you reigned; and indeed I wish you had reigned, so that we too might reign with you.

9 For I think God displayed us apostles last, as sentenced to death, because we became a spectacle to the world and to angels and to people.

10 We are fools because of Christ, but you prudent in Christ; we weak, but you strong; you honored, but we dishonored.

11 Until this present hour we both hunger and thirst and are poorly clothed and are struck and are without a settled home,

12 and labor, working with our own hands. Reviled, we bless; persecuted, we bear it;

13 slandered, we encourage. We became as the world's refuse, everyone's scrapings, until now.

14 I write these things not to shame you, but admonish you as my beloved children.

15 For even if you have ten thousand tutors in Christ, yet not many fathers; for in Christ Jesus through the gospel I begot you.

16 Therefore I urge you, become imitators of me.

17 For this reason I sent you Timothy, who is my beloved child and faithful in the Lord, who will remind you of my ways in Christ, just as I teach everywhere in every church.

18 But some were puffed up as though I were not coming to you.

19 But I will come to you quickly, if the Lord wills, and know not the speech of those puffed up, but the power.

20 For God's kingdom is not in speech but in power.

21 What do you want? Should I come to you with a rod, or in love and a spirit of gentleness?

Chapter 5

1 Sexual immorality is actually reported among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even named among the nations, that someone has his father's wife.

2 And you are puffed up, and did not rather mourn, so that the one who did this deed might be removed from your midst.

3 For I, though absent in body but present in spirit, have already judged, as present, the one who performed this thus,

4 in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when you and my spirit are assembled, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,

5 to hand such a one over to Satan for destruction of the flesh, so that the spirit may be saved on the day of the Lord Jesus.

6 Your boasting is not good. Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump?

7 Therefore clean out the old leaven, so that you may be a new lump, as you are unleavened. For Christ our Passover was also sacrificed for us.

8 So let us keep the feast, not with old leaven nor with leaven of malice and wickedness, but with unleavened things of sincerity and truth.

9 I wrote to you in the letter not to mix together with sexually immoral people,

10 and not altogether with the sexually immoral of this world or the greedy or robbers or idolaters, since then you would have to go out of the world.

11 But now I wrote to you not to mix together if someone named a brother is sexually immoral or greedy or an idolater or a reviler or a drunkard or a robber, not even to eat with such a one.

12 For what is it to me to judge those outside also? Do you not judge those inside?

13 But God judges those outside. And remove the evil one from among yourselves.

Chapter 6

1 Does someone among you, having a matter against the other, dare to be judged before the unrighteous and not before the saints?

2 Do you not know that the saints will judge the world? And if the world is judged by you, are you unworthy of the smallest tribunals?

3 Do you not know that we will judge angels, let alone matters of life?

4 Therefore, if you have tribunals concerning matters of life, do you seat those despised in the church?

5 I say this to your shame. Is there thus no wise one among you, not even one, who will be able to decide between his brother?

6 But brother goes to judgment with brother, and this before unbelievers.

7 Therefore there is already altogether a defeat among you, that you have judgments with yourselves. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be defrauded?

8 But you wrong and defraud, and that brothers.

9 Or do you not know that the unrighteous will not inherit God's kingdom? Do not be deceived: neither sexually immoral people nor idolaters nor adulterers nor effeminate men nor men who bed males,

10 nor thieves nor greedy people nor drunkards nor revilers nor robbers will inherit God's kingdom.

11 And some of you were these things; but you washed yourselves, but you were sanctified, but you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus and in the Spirit of our God.

12 Everything is permitted to me, but not everything benefits. Everything is permitted to me, but I will not be brought under authority by anything.

13 Foods for the belly, and the belly for foods, but God will nullify both it and them. But the body is not for sexual immorality but for the Lord, and the Lord for the body.

14 And God both raised the Lord and will raise us through his power.

15 Do you not know that your bodies are Christ's members? Therefore, taking Christ's members, will I make them a prostitute's members? May it never be!

16 Or do you not know that the one who joins himself to the prostitute is one body? For, he says, “The two will be one flesh.”

17 But the one who joins himself to the Lord is one spirit.

18 Flee sexual immorality. Every sin that a man does is outside the body, but the sexually immoral one sins against his own body.

19 Or do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit within you, whom you have from God, and you are not your own?

20 For you were bought at a price. Therefore glorify God in your body and in your spirit, which are God's.

Chapter 7

1 And concerning what you wrote to me: it is good for a man not to touch a woman.

2 But because of sexual immoralities, let each have his own wife, and let each woman have her own husband.

3 Let the husband repay the wife the goodwill owed, and likewise also the wife the husband.

4 The wife does not have authority over her own body, but the husband; and likewise the husband also does not have authority over his own body, but the wife.

5 Do not deprive one another, except perhaps by agreement for a time, so that you may devote yourselves to fasting and prayer, and come together again, so that Satan may not tempt you because of your lack of self-control.

6 But I say this by concession, not by command.

7 For I want all people to be as myself also; but each has his own gracious gift from God, one thus, another thus.

8 And I say to the unmarried and the widows, it is good for them if they remain as I also am.

9 But if they do not exercise self-control, let them marry; for it is better to marry than to burn.

10 But to the married I command, not I but the Lord, that a wife not separate from a husband,

11 but if she does separate, let her remain unmarried or be reconciled to the husband, and that a husband not leave a wife.

12 But to the rest I say, not the Lord: if some brother has an unbelieving wife and she agrees to dwell with him, let him not leave her.

13 And a woman who has an unbelieving husband, and he agrees to dwell with her, let her not leave him.

14 For the unbelieving husband has been sanctified in the wife, and the unbelieving wife has been sanctified in the husband; otherwise your children are unclean, but now they are holy.

15 But if the unbeliever separates, let him separate. The brother or sister has not been enslaved in such things; but God has called us in peace.

16 For how do you know, wife, whether you will save the husband? Or how do you know, husband, whether you will save the wife?

17 Only, as God apportioned to each, as the Lord has called each, thus let him walk. And thus I direct in all the churches.

18 Was someone called circumcised? Let him not draw the foreskin over. Was someone called in uncircumcision? Let him not be circumcised.

19 Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but keeping God's commandments.

20 Let each remain in the calling in which he was called.

21 Were you called a slave? Do not let it concern you; but if you can also become free, rather make use of it.

22 For the slave called in the Lord is the Lord's freedman; likewise also the free one called is Christ's slave.

23 You were bought at a price; do not become slaves of people.

24 Brothers, let each remain with God in that in which he was called.

25 And concerning virgins, I have no command of the Lord, but give judgment as one who has received mercy from the Lord to be faithful.

26 Therefore I consider this to be good because of the present necessity, that it is good for a man to be thus.

27 Have you been bound to a wife? Do not seek release. Have you been released from a wife? Do not seek a wife.

28 But even if you marry, you did not sin; and if the virgin marries, she did not sin. But such will have affliction in the flesh, and I spare you.

29 But I say this, brothers: the time has been shortened; henceforth, so that even those who have wives may be as not having,

30 and those who weep as not weeping, and those who rejoice as not rejoicing, and those who buy as not possessing,

31 and those who use this world as not using it fully; for the form of this world passes away.

32 But I want you to be without anxiety. The unmarried one is anxious about the Lord's things, how he will please the Lord,

33 but the married one is anxious about the world's things, how he will please the wife.

34 The wife and the virgin are distinguished. The unmarried woman is anxious about the Lord's things, so that she may be holy both in body and in spirit; but the married woman is anxious about the world's things, how she will please the husband.

35 But I say this for your own benefit, not to cast a noose upon you, but for propriety and devoted attendance upon the Lord without distraction.

36 But if someone thinks he behaves indecently toward his virgin, if she is past her prime and it ought to happen thus, let him do what he wants; he does not sin; let them marry.

37 But the one who stands firm in his heart, having no necessity, but has authority concerning his own will, and has judged this in his heart, to keep his own virgin, does well.

38 So also the one who gives in marriage does well, but the one who does not give in marriage does better.

39 A wife is bound by law for as long as her husband lives; but if her husband falls asleep, she is free to be married to whom she wants, only in the Lord.

40 But she is more blessed if she remains thus, according to my judgment; and I think I too have God's Spirit.

Chapter 8

1 And concerning things sacrificed to idols, we know that we all have knowledge. Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up.

2 But if someone thinks he knows something, he has not yet known anything as he ought to know.

3 But if someone loves God, this one has been known by him.

4 Therefore concerning the eating of things sacrificed to idols, we know that an idol is nothing in the world, and that there is no other God except one.

5 For even if there are so-called gods, whether in heaven or upon earth, as there are many gods and many lords,

6 yet for us one God, the Father, from whom are all things and we unto him, and one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom are all things and we through him.

7 But knowledge is not in everyone; and some, with consciousness of the idol until now, eat as a thing sacrificed to an idol, and their conscience, being weak, is defiled.

8 But food does not present us to God; for neither if we eat do we abound, nor if we do not eat do we lack.

9 But watch lest this authority of yours become a stumbling block to the weak.

10 For if someone sees you who have knowledge reclining in an idol's temple, will not his conscience, being weak, be built up to eat things sacrificed to idols?

11 And the weak brother will perish upon your knowledge, for whom Christ died.

12 And thus, sinning against the brothers and striking their weak conscience, you sin against Christ.

13 Therefore, if food offends my brother, I will certainly never eat meat, so that I may not offend my brother.

Chapter 9

1 Am I not an apostle? Am I not free? Have I not seen Jesus Christ our Lord? Are you not my work in the Lord?

2 If to others I am not an apostle, yet indeed to you I am; for you are the seal of my apostleship in the Lord.

3 My defense to those who examine me is this:

4 Do we not have authority to eat and drink?

5 Do we not have authority to take along a sister as wife, as also the other apostles and the Lord's brothers and Cephas?

6 Or do only I and Barnabas not have authority not to work?

7 Who ever serves as a soldier at his own wages? Who plants a vineyard and does not eat from its fruit? Or who shepherds a flock and does not eat from the flock's milk?

8 Do I speak these things according to man? Or does not the law also say these things?

9 For in Moses's law it is written, “You shall not muzzle an ox threshing.” Is God concerned about oxen?

10 Or does he speak altogether for us? For it was written for us, that the plower ought to plow upon hope, and the thresher to share in his hope upon hope.

11 If we sowed spiritual things for you, is it a great thing if we reap your fleshly things?

12 If others share in authority over you, do not we more? But we did not use this authority, but bear everything so that we may give no hindrance to Christ's gospel.

13 Do you not know that those who work the sacred things eat from the sacred place, and those who attend the altar share with the altar?

14 Thus the Lord also directed those who proclaim the gospel to live from the gospel.

15 But I used none of these things. And I did not write these things so that it might happen thus for me; for it is better for me to die than for someone to empty my boast.

16 For if I proclaim the gospel, I have no boast; for necessity lies upon me, and woe is mine if I do not proclaim the gospel.

17 For if willingly I practice this, I have a wage; but if unwillingly, I have been entrusted with a stewardship.

18 What, then, is my wage? That, proclaiming the gospel, I may offer Christ's gospel without expense, so as not to use fully my authority in the gospel.

19 For being free from all, I enslaved myself to all so that I may gain the more.

20 And to the Jews I became as a Jew so that I may gain Jews; to those under law as under law so that I may gain those under law;

21 to those without law as without law, not being without law to God but within law to Christ, so that I may gain those without law.

22 To the weak I became as weak so that I may gain the weak. To all I have become all things so that by all means I may save some.

23 And I do this because of the gospel, so that I may become a fellow sharer of it.

24 Do you not know that those running in a stadium all run, but one receives the prize? Run thus so that you may obtain it.

25 And everyone who competes exercises self-control in everything; they, therefore, to receive a corruptible crown, but we an incorruptible.

26 Therefore I run thus, as not uncertainly; I box thus, as not beating air,

27 but I batter my body and enslave it, lest, having preached to others, I myself become disapproved.

Chapter 10

1 But I do not want you to be ignorant, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud and all passed through the sea,

2 and all were baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea,

3 and all ate the same spiritual food,

4 and all drank the same spiritual drink; for they drank from a spiritual rock following them, and the rock was Christ.

5 But God was not pleased with most of them, for they were strewn in the wilderness.

6 And these things became patterns for us, so that we may not be desirers of evil things, as those also desired.

7 Nor become idolaters, as some of them, as it is written, “The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose to play.”

8 Nor let us commit sexual immorality, as some of them committed sexual immorality, and twenty-three thousand fell in one day.

9 Nor let us test Christ, as some of them also tested him, and perished by the serpents.

10 Nor grumble, as some of them also grumbled and perished by the destroyer.

11 And all these things happened to them as patterns, and were written for our admonition, to whom the ends of the ages have come.

12 So let the one who thinks he stands watch lest he fall.

13 No temptation has taken you except a human one; but God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted beyond what you can bear, but will also make the way out with the temptation, so that you may be able to endure.

14 Therefore, my beloved, flee from idolatry.

15 I speak as to prudent people; judge yourselves what I say.

16 The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not fellowship of Christ's blood? The bread which we break, is it not fellowship of Christ's body?

17 Because there is one bread, we the many are one body; for we all share from the one bread.

18 See Israel according to flesh: are not those who eat the sacrifices sharers of the altar?

19 What, then, do I say? That an idol is anything, or that a thing sacrificed to an idol is anything?

20 But that what the nations sacrifice, they sacrifice to demons and not to God; and I do not want you to become sharers of demons.

21 You cannot drink the Lord's cup and demons' cup; you cannot share in the Lord's table and demons' table.

22 Or do we provoke the Lord to jealousy? Are we stronger than he?

23 Everything is permitted to me, but not everything benefits; everything is permitted to me, but not everything builds up.

24 Let no one seek his own, but each the other's.

25 Eat everything sold in the meat market, examining nothing because of conscience,

26 for “The earth is the Lord's, and its fullness.”

27 And if someone of the unbelievers invites you and you want to go, eat everything set before you, examining nothing because of conscience.

28 But if someone says to you, “This is sacrificed to an idol,” do not eat, because of that one who disclosed it and conscience; for “The earth is the Lord's, and its fullness.”

29 And I mean conscience, not one's own but the other's. For why is my freedom judged by another conscience?

30 But if I partake with thanks, why am I slandered for that for which I give thanks?

31 Therefore, whether you eat or drink or do anything, do everything unto God's glory.

32 Become without offense both to Jews and Greeks and to God's church,

33 just as I too please all in everything, not seeking my own benefit but that of the many, so that they may be saved.

Chapter 11

1 Become imitators of me, just as I also of Christ.

2 And I praise you, brothers, that you remember me in everything and hold the traditions just as I handed them over to you.

3 But I want you to know that Christ is the head of every man, and the man the head of a woman, and God the head of Christ.

4 Every man praying or prophesying with something down over his head shames his head.

5 But every woman praying or prophesying with her head uncovered shames her own head; for it is one and the same with the shaved woman.

6 For if a woman is not covered, let her also be shorn; but if it is shameful for a woman to be shorn or shaved, let her be covered.

7 For a man ought not to cover his head, being God's image and glory; but the woman is man's glory.

8 For man is not from woman, but woman from man;

9 for neither was man created because of the woman, but woman because of the man.

10 For this reason the woman ought to have authority upon her head because of the angels.

11 Nevertheless, neither man apart from woman nor woman apart from man in the Lord.

12 For just as the woman is from the man, so also the man through the woman, but all things from God.

13 Judge among yourselves: is it fitting for a woman to pray to God uncovered?

14 Or does not nature itself teach you that if a man has long hair, it is dishonor to him,

15 but if a woman has long hair, it is glory to her, because the hair has been given to her instead of a covering?

16 But if someone thinks to be contentious, we have no such custom, nor God's churches.

17 But in commanding this I do not praise you, because you assemble not for the better but for the worse.

18 For first, when you assemble in the church, I hear that divisions exist among you, and in some part I believe it.

19 For there must also be factions among you, so that the approved may become manifest among you.

20 Therefore, when you assemble together, it is not to eat the Lord's supper.

21 For each takes his own supper beforehand in eating, and one is hungry, but another is drunk.

22 For do you not have houses for eating and drinking? Or do you despise God's church and shame those who have nothing? What should I say to you? Will I praise you in this? I do not praise you.

23 For I received from the Lord what I also handed over to you, that the Lord Jesus, on the night in which he was handed over, took bread,

24 and having given thanks, broke it and said, “Take, eat; this is my body, broken for you; do this for my remembrance.”

25 Likewise also the cup after supping, saying, “This cup is the new covenant in my blood; do this, as often as you drink, for my remembrance.”

26 For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes.

27 So whoever eats this bread or drinks the Lord's cup unworthily will be guilty of the Lord's body and blood.

28 But let a man examine himself, and thus let him eat from the bread and drink from the cup.

29 For the one who eats and drinks unworthily eats and drinks judgment to himself, not discerning the Lord's body.

30 Because of this many among you are weak and sick, and quite a few sleep.

31 For if we discerned ourselves, we would not be judged.

32 But being judged by the Lord, we are disciplined, so that we may not be condemned with the world.

33 So, my brothers, when assembling to eat, wait for one another.

34 But if someone is hungry, let him eat at home, so that you may not assemble unto judgment; and the remaining things I will direct when I come.

Chapter 12

1 And concerning spiritual things, brothers, I do not want you to be ignorant.

2 You know that you were nations, carried away to the voiceless idols however you were led.

3 Therefore I make known to you that no one speaking in God's Spirit says, “Jesus accursed,” and no one can say, “Jesus Lord,” except in the Holy Spirit.

4 And there are varieties of gracious gifts, but the same Spirit,

5 and varieties of ministries, and the same Lord,

6 and varieties of workings, but the same God who works all things in all.

7 And to each is given the manifestation of the Spirit for benefit.

8 For to one through the Spirit is given a word of wisdom, and to another a word of knowledge according to the same Spirit,

9 and to another faith in the same Spirit, and to another gracious gifts of healings in the same Spirit,

10 and to another workings of powers, and to another prophecy, and to another discernings of spirits, and to another kinds of tongues, and to another interpretation of tongues.

11 And all these the one and the same Spirit works, distributing individually to each just as he wills.

12 For just as the body is one and has many members, and all the members of the one body, being many, are one body, so also Christ.

13 For also in one Spirit we all were baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether slaves or free, and all were given one Spirit to drink.

14 For also the body is not one member but many.

15 If the foot says, “Because I am not a hand, I am not of the body,” it is not on this account not of the body.

16 And if the ear says, “Because I am not an eye, I am not of the body,” it is not on this account not of the body.

17 If the whole body were an eye, where the hearing? If the whole hearing, where the smelling?

18 But now God placed the members, each one of them, in the body just as he wanted.

19 But if all were one member, where the body?

20 But now many members, yet one body.

21 And the eye cannot say to the hand, “I have no need of you,” or again the head to the feet, “I have no need of you.”

22 But much rather the members of the body that seem to be weaker are necessary,

23 and those we think to be less honorable of the body, upon these we put more abundant honor, and our indecent parts have more abundant decency,

24 but our decent parts have no need. But God blended the body together, giving more abundant honor to the lacking part,

25 so that there may be no division in the body, but the members may have the same concern for one another.

26 And whether one member suffers, all the members suffer together; or one member is glorified, all the members rejoice together.

27 But you are Christ's body, and members individually.

28 And God placed some in the church: first apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then powers, then gracious gifts of healings, helps, governings, kinds of tongues.

29 Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Are all powers?

30 Do all have gracious gifts of healings? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret?

31 But be zealous for the better gracious gifts; and I show you a way beyond measure.

Chapter 13

1 If I speak in the tongues of people and angels but have no love, I have become sounding bronze or a clanging cymbal.

2 And if I have prophecy and know all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have all faith so as to move mountains, but have no love, I am nothing.

3 And if I distribute all my possessions as food, and if I hand over my body so that I may be burned, but have no love, I benefit nothing.

4 Love is patient, love acts kindly; love is not jealous, does not boast, is not puffed up,

5 does not behave indecently, does not seek its own things, is not provoked, does not reckon the evil,

6 does not rejoice over unrighteousness, but rejoices together with the truth;

7 bears everything, believes everything, hopes everything, endures everything.

8 Love never falls away; but whether prophecies, they will be nullified; whether tongues, they will cease; whether knowledge, it will be nullified.

9 For we know in part and prophesy in part,

10 but when the perfect comes, then the partial will be nullified.

11 When I was an infant, I spoke as an infant, thought as an infant, reasoned as an infant; but when I have become a man, I have nullified the infant's things.

12 For now we see through a mirror in a riddle, but then face to face; now I know in part, but then I will know fully, just as I also was fully known.

13 But now faith, hope, love remain, these three; but greater than these is love.

Chapter 14

1 Pursue love, and be zealous for spiritual things, but rather that you may prophesy.

2 For the one speaking in a tongue speaks not to people but to God, for no one hears, but in spirit he speaks mysteries.

3 But the one prophesying speaks to people building up and encouragement and consolation.

4 The one speaking in a tongue builds himself up, but the one prophesying builds up a church.

5 And I want you all to speak in tongues, but rather that you may prophesy; for greater is the one prophesying than the one speaking in tongues, unless he interprets, so that the church may receive building up.

6 But now, brothers, if I come to you speaking in tongues, what will I benefit you unless I speak to you either in revelation or knowledge or prophecy or teaching?

7 Even lifeless things giving a sound, whether flute or lyre, if they do not give a distinction in the notes, how will what is played on the flute or lyre be known?

8 For also if a trumpet gives an unclear sound, who will prepare for war?

9 Thus you too, unless through the tongue you give a clear word, how will what is spoken be known? For you will be speaking into air.

10 There are, perhaps, so many kinds of sounds in the world, and none of them voiceless.

11 Therefore, if I do not know the force of the sound, I will be a barbarian to the one speaking, and the one speaking a barbarian to me.

12 Thus you too, since you are zealous for spirits, seek to abound toward building up the church.

13 Therefore let the one speaking in a tongue pray that he may interpret.

14 For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my mind is fruitless.

15 What, then, is it? I will pray with the spirit, but also pray with the mind; I will sing with the spirit, but also sing with the mind.

16 Otherwise, if you bless with the spirit, how will the one filling the place of the untrained say the Amen at your thanksgiving, since he does not know what you say?

17 For you indeed give thanks well, but the other is not built up.

18 I thank my God, speaking in tongues more than all of you;

19 but in church I want to speak five words through my mind, so that I may also instruct others, rather than ten thousand words in a tongue.

20 Brothers, do not become children in understanding, but be infants in malice, and become mature in understanding.

21 In the law it is written, “In other tongues and in other lips I will speak to this people, and not even thus will they listen to me, says the Lord.”

22 So tongues are for a sign, not to believers but to unbelievers, but prophecy not to unbelievers but to believers.

23 Therefore, if the whole church assembles together and all speak in tongues, and untrained people or unbelievers enter, will they not say that you are mad?

24 But if all prophesy, and some unbeliever or untrained person enters, he is convicted by all, examined by all,

25 and thus the hidden things of his heart become manifest, and thus, falling upon his face, he will worship God, announcing that God really is among you.

26 What, then, is it, brothers? Whenever you assemble, each of you has a psalm, has a teaching, has a tongue, has a revelation, has an interpretation; let everything happen for building up.

27 If someone speaks in a tongue, by two or at most three, and in turn, and let one interpret.

28 But if there is no interpreter, let him be silent in church, but speak to himself and to God.

29 And let two or three prophets speak, and let the others discern.

30 But if it is revealed to another sitting, let the first be silent.

31 For you can all prophesy one by one, so that all may learn and all be encouraged.

32 And prophets' spirits submit to prophets.

33 For God is not of disorder but of peace, as in all the churches of the saints.

34 Let your women be silent in the churches; for it has not been permitted them to speak, but to submit, as the law also says.

35 But if they want to learn anything, let them ask their own husbands at home; for it is shameful for women to speak in church.

36 Or did God's word go out from you? Or did it reach you alone?

37 If someone thinks he is a prophet or spiritual, let him acknowledge that what I write to you are the Lord's commandments.

38 But if someone is ignorant, let him be ignorant.

39 So, brothers, be zealous to prophesy, and do not prevent speaking in tongues.

40 Let everything happen decently and according to order.

Chapter 15

1 And I make known to you, brothers, the gospel which I proclaimed to you, which you also received, in which you also stand,

2 through which you are also saved, if you hold to the word with which I proclaimed it to you, unless you believed in vain.

3 For I handed over to you among the first things what I also received, that Christ died for our sins according to the writings,

4 and that he was buried, and that he has been raised on the third day according to the writings,

5 and that he appeared to Cephas, then to the twelve,

6 then appeared to above five hundred brothers at once, of whom most remain until now, but some also fell asleep,

7 then appeared to James, then to all the apostles,

8 and last of all, as to the aborted one, he appeared to me also.

9 For I am the least of the apostles, who am not fit to be called an apostle, because I persecuted God's church.

10 But by God's grace I am what I am, and his grace toward me did not become empty, but I labored more abundantly than them all; yet not I, but God's grace with me.

11 Therefore, whether I or they, thus we preach, and thus you believed.

12 But if Christ is preached that he has been raised from the dead, how do some among you say that there is no resurrection of the dead?

13 But if there is no resurrection of the dead, neither has Christ been raised.

14 And if Christ has not been raised, then our proclamation is empty, and your faith also empty.

15 And we are also found false witnesses of God, because we testified against God that he raised Christ, whom he did not raise, if indeed the dead are not raised.

16 For if the dead are not raised, neither has Christ been raised.

17 And if Christ has not been raised, your faith is futile; you are still in your sins.

18 Then those who fell asleep in Christ also perished.

19 If in this life only we have hoped in Christ, we are more pitiable than all people.

20 But now Christ has been raised from the dead; he became firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep.

21 For since through man came death, also through man resurrection of the dead.

22 For just as in Adam all die, so also in Christ all will be made alive.

23 But each in his own order: Christ firstfruits, then those of Christ at his coming,

24 then the end, when he hands over the kingdom to God and Father, when he nullifies every rule and every authority and power.

25 For he must reign until he places all the enemies under his feet.

26 The last enemy nullified is death.

27 For he subjected all things under his feet; but when he says that all things have been subjected, it is clear that the one who subjected all things to him is excepted.

28 But when all things are subjected to him, then the Son himself also will be subjected to the one who subjected all things to him, so that God may be all things in all.

29 Otherwise, what will those baptized for the dead do? If the dead are not raised at all, why are they also baptized for the dead?

30 Why do we also face danger every hour?

31 Daily I die, by our boasting which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord.

32 If according to man I fought beasts in Ephesus, what is the benefit to me? If the dead are not raised, let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die.

33 Do not be deceived: bad associations corrupt good habits.

34 Become sober righteously and do not sin; for some have ignorance of God; I say this to your shame.

35 But someone will say, “How are the dead raised? And with what sort of body do they come?”

36 Fool, what you sow is not made alive unless it dies.

37 And what you sow, you do not sow the body that will become, but a bare grain, perhaps of wheat or of some of the others.

38 But God gives it a body just as he wanted, and to each of the seeds its own body.

39 Not all flesh is the same flesh, but one flesh of people, another flesh of livestock, another of fish, another of birds.

40 And heavenly bodies and earthly bodies, but different is the glory of the heavenly and different that of the earthly.

41 One glory of sun, and another glory of moon, and another glory of stars; for star differs from star in glory.

42 Thus also the resurrection of the dead: it is sown in corruption, raised in incorruptibility;

43 sown in dishonor, raised in glory; sown in weakness, raised in power;

44 sown a natural body, raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body, and there is a spiritual body.

45 Thus it is also written, “The first man Adam became a living soul”; the last Adam a life-giving spirit.

46 But the spiritual is not first, but the natural, then the spiritual.

47 The first man from earth, made of dust; the second man, the Lord from heaven.

48 As the one of dust, such also those of dust; and as the heavenly one, such also the heavenly ones.

49 And just as we bore the image of the one of dust, we will also bear the image of the heavenly one.

50 But I say this, brothers, that flesh and blood cannot inherit God's kingdom, nor does corruption inherit incorruptibility.

51 Look, I tell you a mystery: we will not all sleep, but we will all be changed,

52 in an instant, in a blink of an eye, at the last trumpet; for it will sound, and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed.

53 For this corruptible must put on incorruptibility, and this mortal put on immortality.

54 But when this corruptible puts on incorruptibility and this mortal puts on immortality, then will come the word that is written, “Death was swallowed unto victory.”

55 Where, death, is your sting? Where, Hades, is your victory?

56 And the sting of death is sin, and the power of sin the law.

57 But thanks to God who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

58 So, my beloved brothers, become firm, immovable, always abounding in the Lord's work, knowing that your labor is not empty in the Lord.

Chapter 16

1 And concerning the collection for the saints, just as I directed the churches of Galatia, so you too do.

2 On the first of the week, let each of you lay aside with himself, storing up whatever he prospers in, so that collections may not happen then when I come.

3 And when I arrive, whomever you approve, these I will send through letters to carry your gift to Jerusalem.

4 But if it is worthy for me also to go, they will go with me.

5 And I will come to you when I pass through Macedonia, for I am passing through Macedonia.

6 And perhaps I will remain with you or even winter, so that you may send me onward wherever I go.

7 For I do not want to see you now in passing, but hope to remain with you some time, if the Lord permits.

8 But I remain in Ephesus until Pentecost.

9 For a great and effective door has opened for me, and many opponents.

10 And if Timothy comes, watch that he may be with you without fear, for he works the Lord's work, as I also do.

11 Therefore let no one despise him, but send him onward in peace so that he may come to me, for I await him with the brothers.

12 And concerning Apollos the brother, I urged him much to come to you with the brothers, and it was altogether not his will to come now, but he will come when he has opportunity.

13 Keep watch, stand in the faith, act as men, be strengthened.

14 Let all your things happen in love.

15 And I urge you, brothers—you know Stephanas's household, that it is firstfruits of Achaia, and they appointed themselves to ministry to the saints—

16 that you too submit to such people and to everyone working together and laboring.

17 And I rejoice at the presence of Stephanas and Fortunatus and Achaicus, because these filled up your lack.

18 For they refreshed my spirit and yours; therefore acknowledge such people.

19 The churches of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you much in the Lord, with the church in their house.

20 All the brothers greet you. Greet one another with a holy kiss.

21 The greeting by my own hand, Paul's.

22 If someone does not love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be accursed. Maran atha.

23 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with you.

24 My love be with all of you in Christ Jesus. Amen.

2 Corinthians

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ through God's will, and Timothy the brother, to God's church in Corinth, with all the saints in all Achaia:

2 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 Blessed is the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of compassions and God of all encouragement,

4 who encourages us in all our affliction, so that we may be able to encourage those in every affliction through the encouragement with which we ourselves are encouraged by God.

5 Because just as Christ's sufferings abound toward us, so through Christ our encouragement also abounds.

6 And whether we are afflicted, it is for your encouragement and salvation, which works in endurance of the same sufferings that we also suffer; or whether we are encouraged, it is for your encouragement and salvation, and our hope is firm concerning you,

7 knowing that just as you are sharers of the sufferings, so also of the encouragement.

8 For we do not want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning our affliction that happened to us in Asia, that we were burdened exceedingly, beyond power, so that we despaired even of living.

9 But we ourselves have had the sentence of death within ourselves, so that we may not trust in ourselves but in God who raises the dead,

10 who rescued us from so great a death and rescues, in whom we have hoped that he will also still rescue,

11 you also helping together for us in petition, so that the gracious gift toward us from many persons may be thanked for by many on our behalf.

12 For our boasting is this, the testimony of our conscience, that in simplicity and sincerity of God, not in fleshly wisdom but in God's grace, we conducted ourselves in the world, and more abundantly toward you.

13 For we write no other things to you than what you read or also acknowledge, and I hope that you will also acknowledge until the end,

14 just as you also acknowledged us in part, that we are your boast, just as you also ours on the day of the Lord Jesus.

15 And in this confidence I intended to come to you earlier, so that you might have a second grace,

16 and pass through you to Macedonia, and again from Macedonia come to you, and be sent onward by you to Judea.

17 Therefore, intending this, did I then use fickleness? Or do I plan what I plan according to flesh, so that with me there may be the Yes, yes and the No, no?

18 But God is faithful, that our word toward you did not become Yes and No.

19 For God's Son Jesus Christ, who was preached among you through us, through me and Silvanus and Timothy, did not become Yes and No, but in him has become Yes.

20 For as many as are God's promises, in him is the Yes and in him the Amen, to God for glory through us.

21 And the one who confirms us with you unto Christ and anointed us is God,

22 who also sealed us and gave the pledge of the Spirit in our hearts.

23 But I call upon God as witness upon my soul, that sparing you I no longer came to Corinth.

24 Not that we rule over your faith, but we are fellow workers of your joy, for by faith you stand.

Chapter 2

1 But I decided this for myself, not to come to you again in grief.

2 For if I grieve you, who then is the one who gladdens me except the one grieved by me?

3 And I wrote this very thing to you, so that when I come I may not have grief from those from whom I ought to rejoice, trusting in all of you that my joy is that of you all.

4 For from much affliction and anguish of heart I wrote to you through many tears, not so that you may be grieved, but so that you may know the love which I have more abundantly toward you.

5 But if someone has caused grief, he has grieved not me, but in part, so that I may not burden you all.

6 Sufficient for such a one is this punishment by the majority,

7 so that on the contrary you should rather forgive and encourage, lest such a one be swallowed by more abundant grief.

8 Therefore I urge you to confirm love toward him.

9 For to this end I also wrote, so that I may know your proven character, whether you are obedient in everything.

10 And to whom you forgive anything, I also; for also I, if I have forgiven anything, what I have forgiven, it is because of you in Christ's presence,

11 so that we may not be exploited by Satan, for we are not ignorant of his designs.

12 And coming to Troas for Christ's gospel, and a door having been opened for me in the Lord,

13 I have had no relief in my spirit because I did not find Titus my brother, but taking leave of them I went out to Macedonia.

14 But thanks to God, who always leads us in triumph in Christ and manifests through us the odor of his knowledge in every place,

15 because we are Christ's fragrance to God among those being saved and among those perishing,

16 to these an odor of death unto death, but to those an odor of life unto life. And who is sufficient for these things?

17 For we are not as the many, peddling God's word, but as from sincerity, but as from God, before God, we speak in Christ.

Chapter 3

1 Are we beginning again to commend ourselves? Or do we need, as some, commendatory letters to you or commendatory letters from you?

2 You are our letter, inscribed in our hearts, known and read by all people,

3 being manifested that you are Christ's letter ministered by us, inscribed not with ink but with the Spirit of the living God, not on stone tablets but on fleshly tablets of heart.

4 And we have such confidence through Christ toward God,

5 not that we are sufficient from ourselves to reckon anything as from ourselves, but our sufficiency is from God,

6 who also made us sufficient as ministers of a new covenant, not of letter but of spirit; for the letter kills, but the spirit gives life.

7 But if the ministry of death, imprinted in letters on stones, came in glory, so that Israel's sons could not gaze upon Moses's face because of the glory of his face, which was being nullified,

8 how will the ministry of the Spirit not rather be in glory?

9 For if the ministry of condemnation is glory, much more the ministry of righteousness abounds in glory.

10 For even what has been glorified has not been glorified in this respect, because of the surpassing glory.

11 For if what is being nullified is through glory, much more what remains is in glory.

12 Therefore, having such hope, we use much boldness,

13 and not as Moses put a veil upon his own face so that Israel's sons might not gaze upon the end of what was being nullified.

14 But their minds were hardened; for until today the same veil remains at the reading of the old covenant, not unveiled, because it is nullified in Christ.

15 But until today, whenever Moses is read, a veil lies upon their heart.

16 But whenever it turns toward the Lord, the veil is taken away.

17 And the Lord is the Spirit, and where the Lord's Spirit is, there is freedom.

18 But we all, with unveiled face beholding as in a mirror the Lord's glory, are transformed into the same image from glory to glory, as from the Lord, the Spirit.

Chapter 4

1 For this reason, having this ministry, just as we received mercy, we do not lose heart,

2 but renounced the hidden things of shame, not walking in cunning nor adulterating God's word, but by manifestation of the truth commending ourselves to every conscience of people before God.

3 But even if our gospel is veiled, it is veiled among those perishing,

4 among whom the god of this age blinded the minds of the unbelievers, so that the illumination of the gospel of Christ's glory, who is God's image, might not shine upon them.

5 For we preach not ourselves but Christ Jesus as Lord, and ourselves your slaves because of Jesus,

6 because God, who said for light to shine from darkness, is the one who shone in our hearts for illumination of the knowledge of God's glory in Jesus Christ's face.

7 But we have this treasure in earthen vessels, so that the excess of power may be God's and not from us,

8 afflicted in everything, but not confined; perplexed, but not despairing;

9 persecuted, but not abandoned; struck down, but not perishing;

10 always carrying around in the body the dying of the Lord Jesus, so that Jesus's life also may be manifested in our body.

11 For we who live are always handed over to death because of Jesus, so that Jesus's life also may be manifested in our mortal flesh.

12 So death works in us, but life in you.

13 And having the same spirit of faith, according to what is written, “I believed, therefore I spoke,” we too believe, therefore also speak,

14 knowing that the one who raised the Lord Jesus will also raise us through Jesus and present us with you.

15 For all things are because of you, so that grace, increasing through the more, may cause thanksgiving to abound unto God's glory.

16 Therefore we do not lose heart; but even if our outer man is being destroyed, yet the inner is renewed day by day.

17 For the momentary lightness of our affliction works for us, beyond measure unto beyond measure, an eternal weight of glory,

18 while we look not at the things seen but the things not seen; for the things seen are temporary, but the things not seen eternal.

Chapter 5

1 For we know that if our earthly house of the tent is torn down, we have a building from God, a house not made by hands, eternal in the heavens.

2 For also in this we groan, longing to put on over ourselves our dwelling from heaven,

3 if indeed, having put it on, we will not be found naked.

4 For also we who are in the tent groan, burdened, because we do not want to be unclothed but clothed over, so that the mortal may be swallowed by life.

5 And the one who worked us for this very thing is God, who also gave us the pledge of the Spirit.

6 Therefore always being confident, and knowing that while at home in the body we are away from the Lord—

7 for we walk through faith, not through sight—

8 but we are confident and rather pleased to be away from the body and at home with the Lord.

9 Therefore we also aspire, whether at home or away, to be pleasing to him.

10 For we all must be manifested before Christ's judgment seat, so that each may receive the things through the body according to what he practiced, whether good or evil.

11 Therefore, knowing the Lord's fear, we persuade people, but have been manifested to God; and I hope also to have been manifested in your consciences.

12 For we do not again commend ourselves to you, but give you an opportunity of boasting for us, so that you may have an answer to those boasting in face and not heart.

13 For whether we were out of our minds, it is to God; whether we are sound-minded, to you.

14 For Christ's love constrains us, having judged this, that if one died for all, then all died;

15 and he died for all, so that those living may no longer live to themselves but to the one who died and was raised for them.

16 So from now we know no one according to flesh; and even if we have known Christ according to flesh, yet now we no longer know him thus.

17 So if someone is in Christ, a new creation; the ancient things passed away; look, all things have become new.

18 And all things are from God, who reconciled us to himself through Jesus Christ and gave us the ministry of reconciliation,

19 that God was in Christ reconciling a world to himself, not reckoning their trespasses to them, and placing in us the word of reconciliation.

20 Therefore we act as ambassadors for Christ, as God urges through us; we petition for Christ: be reconciled to God.

21 For he made the one who did not know sin sin for us, so that we may become God's righteousness in him.

Chapter 6

1 And working together, we also urge you not to receive God's grace in vain.

2 For he says, “At an acceptable time I listened to you, and on a day of salvation I helped you.” Look, now an acceptable time; look, now a day of salvation.

3 Giving no stumbling in anything, so that the ministry may not be blamed,

4 but in everything commending ourselves as God's ministers, in much endurance, in afflictions, in necessities, in distresses,

5 in blows, in prisons, in disorders, in labors, in sleeplessness, in fastings,

6 in purity, in knowledge, in patience, in kindness, in the Holy Spirit, in unhypocritical love,

7 in a word of truth, in God's power, through the weapons of righteousness on the right and left,

8 through glory and dishonor, through ill repute and good repute; as deceivers and true,

9 as unknown and fully known, as dying and look, we live, as disciplined and not put to death,

10 as grieving but always rejoicing, as poor but enriching many, as having nothing and possessing everything.

11 Our mouth has opened toward you, Corinthians; our heart has been widened.

12 You are not confined in us, but are confined in your inward affections.

13 And for the same recompense—I speak as to children—be widened, you too.

14 Do not become unequally yoked with unbelievers. For what partnership is there for righteousness and lawlessness? And what fellowship for light with darkness?

15 And what agreement for Christ with Beliar? Or what portion for a believer with an unbeliever?

16 And what accord for God's temple with idols? For you are a temple of the living God, just as God said, “I will dwell in them and walk among them, and I will be their God, and they will be my people.”

17 Therefore, “Come out from their midst and be set apart, says the Lord, and do not touch an unclean thing, and I will receive you,

18 and will be a Father to you, and you will be sons and daughters to me, says the Lord Almighty.”

Chapter 7

1 Therefore, having these promises, beloved, let us cleanse ourselves from every defilement of flesh and spirit, completing holiness in God's fear.

2 Make room for us. We wronged no one, corrupted no one, exploited no one.

3 I do not speak for condemnation, for I have said beforehand that you are in our hearts, to die together and live together.

4 Much is my boldness toward you, much my boasting for you; I have been filled with encouragement, I overflow with joy in all our affliction.

5 For also when we came to Macedonia, our flesh has had no relief, but being afflicted in everything: fights outside, fears within.

6 But God, who encourages the lowly, encouraged us by Titus's presence,

7 and not only by his presence but also by the encouragement with which he was encouraged over you, reporting to us your longing, your lamentation, your zeal for me, so that I rejoiced more.

8 Because even if I grieved you with the letter, I do not regret it, even if I did regret it; for I see that that letter grieved you, even if for an hour.

9 Now I rejoice, not that you were grieved, but that you were grieved unto repentance; for you were grieved according to God, so that you might suffer loss in nothing from us.

10 For grief according to God works repentance unto salvation without regret, but the world's grief works death.

11 For look, this very thing, your being grieved according to God, how much diligence it worked in you, indeed defense, indeed indignation, indeed fear, indeed longing, indeed zeal, indeed vengeance! In everything you commended yourselves as pure in the matter.

12 Therefore, even if I wrote to you, it was not because of the one who wronged nor because of the one wronged, but for your diligence for us to be manifested to you before God.

13 For this reason we have been encouraged in your encouragement, and much more we rejoiced over Titus's joy, because his spirit has been refreshed by you all.

14 Because if I have boasted anything to him for you, I was not shamed; but as we spoke everything in truth to you, so also our boasting before Titus became truth.

15 And his inward affections are more abundantly toward you, as he remembers the obedience of you all, how with fear and trembling you received him.

16 I rejoice that in everything I have confidence in you.

Chapter 8

1 And we make known to you, brothers, God's grace given in the churches of Macedonia,

2 that in much trial of affliction the abundance of their joy and their deep poverty abounded unto the riches of their simplicity.

3 Because according to power, I testify, and beyond power, of their own choice,

4 with much urging petitioning us to receive the gift and the fellowship of the ministry to the saints,

5 and not as we hoped, but they gave themselves first to the Lord and to us through God's will,

6 so that we urged Titus that just as he began beforehand, so he might also complete this grace toward you.

7 But just as you abound in everything, faith and word and knowledge and all diligence and the love from you in us, so also abound in this grace.

8 I speak not by command, but through the diligence of others also testing the genuineness of your love.

9 For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that because of you he became poor, being rich, so that by his poverty you may become rich.

10 And I give judgment in this, for this benefits you, who began beforehand from last year not only to do but also to will.

11 But now also complete the doing, so that just as the eagerness to will, so also the completing may be from what you have.

12 For if the eagerness is present, it is acceptable according to whatever someone has, not according to what he does not have.

13 For not so that others have relief and you affliction, but from equality, at the present time your abundance for their lack,

14 so that their abundance also may become for your lack, so that equality may come,

15 as it is written, “The one with much did not have excess, and the one with little did not have less.”

16 But thanks to God who gives the same diligence for you in Titus's heart,

17 because he received the urging, but being more diligent, of his own choice he went out to you.

18 And we sent together with him the brother whose praise in the gospel is through all the churches,

19 and not only this, but also appointed by the churches as our fellow traveler with this gift ministered by us, for the Lord's own glory and your eagerness,

20 avoiding this, that someone may blame us in this abundance ministered by us,

21 taking forethought for good things not only before the Lord but also before people.

22 And we sent with them our brother, whom we tested in many things often as diligent, but now much more diligent through much confidence toward you.

23 Whether concerning Titus, he is my partner and fellow worker toward you; whether our brothers, apostles of churches, Christ's glory.

24 Therefore demonstrate to them, and before the churches, the demonstration of your love and our boasting for you.

Chapter 9

1 For concerning the ministry to the saints, it is superfluous for me to write to you.

2 For I know your eagerness, which I boast of for you to Macedonians, that Achaia has been prepared from last year, and the zeal from you stirred up the majority.

3 But I sent the brothers, so that our boast for you may not be emptied in this respect, so that, as I said, you may be prepared,

4 lest, if Macedonians come with me and find you unprepared, we—to avoid saying you—may be shamed in this confidence of boasting.

5 Therefore I considered it necessary to urge the brothers to come beforehand to you and prepare beforehand your blessing announced beforehand, for this to be ready thus as a blessing and not as greed.

6 But this: the one sowing sparingly will also reap sparingly, and the one sowing upon blessings will also reap upon blessings.

7 Each just as he chooses in his heart, not from grief or necessity; for God loves a cheerful giver.

8 And God is able to make all grace abound toward you, so that in everything, always having all sufficiency, you may abound unto every good work,

9 as it is written, “He scattered, he gave to the poor; his righteousness remains forever.”

10 And may the one supplying seed to the sower and bread for eating supply and multiply your seed and increase the produce of your righteousness,

11 being enriched in everything unto all simplicity, which works thanksgiving to God through us.

12 Because the ministry of this service not only fills up the lacks of the saints, but also abounds through many thanksgivings to God,

13 through the proof of this ministry glorifying God for the submission of your confession to Christ's gospel and simplicity of fellowship toward them and toward all,

14 and in their petition for you, longing for you because of God's surpassing grace upon you.

15 But thanks to God for his indescribable gift.

Chapter 10

1 And I myself, Paul, urge you through Christ's gentleness and fairness, who face to face am lowly among you, but absent am confident toward you.

2 But I petition that when present I may not be confident with the confidence with which I reckon to dare against some who reckon us as walking according to flesh.

3 For walking in flesh, we do not wage war according to flesh,

4 for the weapons of our warfare are not fleshly, but powerful with God for pulling down strongholds,

5 pulling down reasonings and every height raised against God's knowledge, and taking every thought captive to Christ's obedience,

6 and having readiness to avenge every disobedience, when your obedience is fulfilled.

7 Look at the things before your face. If someone trusts himself to be Christ's, let him reckon this again from himself, that just as he is Christ's, so we too are Christ's.

8 For even if I boast something more abundantly concerning our authority, which the Lord gave us for building up and not for pulling you down, I will not be shamed,

9 so that I may not seem as though to frighten you through the letters.

10 Because, he says, “The letters are weighty and strong, but the presence of the body weak and the speech despised.”

11 Let such a one reckon this, that as we are in word through letters when absent, such also when present in deed.

12 For we do not dare to class or compare ourselves with some of those commending themselves; but they, measuring themselves among themselves and comparing themselves with themselves, do not understand.

13 But we will not boast beyond measure, but according to the measure of the rule which God apportioned to us, a measure to reach even as far as you.

14 For we do not overstretch ourselves as though not reaching you, for we reached even you in Christ's gospel,

15 not boasting beyond measure in others' labors, but having hope, as your faith grows, to be enlarged among you according to our rule unto abundance,

16 to proclaim the gospel to the regions beyond you, not to boast in another's rule in things ready.

17 But let the one boasting boast in the Lord.

18 For not the one commending himself is approved, but the one whom the Lord commends.

Chapter 11

1 I wish you would bear with me a little in foolishness; but indeed bear with me.

2 For I am jealous for you with God's jealousy, for I betrothed you to one husband, to present a pure virgin to Christ.

3 But I fear lest, as the serpent deceived Eve in his cunning, so your minds be corrupted from the simplicity toward Christ.

4 For if the one coming preaches another Jesus whom we did not preach, or you receive a different spirit which you did not receive, or a different gospel which you did not accept, you bore it well.

5 For I reckon to have lacked nothing of the exceedingly great apostles.

6 But even if untrained in speech, yet not in knowledge; but in everything we were manifested in all things toward you.

7 Or did I commit sin, humbling myself so that you may be exalted, because I proclaimed God's gospel to you freely?

8 I robbed other churches, receiving wages for ministry to you.

9 And present with you and lacking, I burdened no one, for the brothers coming from Macedonia filled up my lack; and in everything I kept myself unburdensome to you and will keep myself so.

10 Christ's truth is in me, that this boasting will not be sealed up for me in the regions of Achaia.

11 Why? Because I do not love you? God knows.

12 But what I do I will also do, so that I may cut off the opportunity of those wanting an opportunity, so that in what they boast they may be found just as we also.

13 For such people are false apostles, deceitful workers, transforming themselves into Christ's apostles.

14 And no wonder, for Satan himself transforms himself into an angel of light.

15 Therefore no great thing if his ministers also transform themselves as ministers of righteousness, whose end will be according to their works.

16 Again I say, let no one think me foolish; but otherwise receive me even as foolish, so that I too may boast a little.

17 What I speak I speak not according to the Lord, but as in foolishness, in this confidence of boasting.

18 Since many boast according to flesh, I too will boast.

19 For gladly you bear with the foolish, being prudent.

20 For you bear it if someone enslaves you, if someone devours, if someone takes, if someone exalts himself, if someone beats you in the face.

21 I speak according to dishonor, as though we were weak; but in whatever someone dares—I speak in foolishness—I too dare.

22 Are they Hebrews? I too. Are they Israelites? I too. Are they Abraham's seed? I too.

23 Are they Christ's ministers? I speak as deranged: I more; in labors more abundantly, in blows exceedingly, in prisons more abundantly, in deaths often.

24 From Jews five times I received forty less one.

25 Three times I was beaten with rods, once stoned, three times shipwrecked; I have spent a night and day in the deep;

26 in journeys often, in dangers of rivers, dangers of robbers, dangers from kin, dangers from nations, dangers in city, dangers in wilderness, dangers in sea, dangers among false brothers;

27 in labor and toil, in sleeplessness often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings often, in cold and nakedness.

28 Apart from the things besides, my daily pressure, the concern of all the churches.

29 Who is weak, and I am not weak? Who is offended, and I do not burn?

30 If I must boast, I will boast of the things of my weakness.

31 The God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who is blessed forever, knows that I do not lie.

32 In Damascus the ethnarch of Aretas the king guarded the city of the Damascenes, wanting to seize me,

33 and through a window in a basket I was lowered through the wall, and escaped his hands.

Chapter 12

1 Indeed, boasting does not benefit me, for I will come to visions and revelations of the Lord.

2 I know a man in Christ fourteen years ago—whether in body I do not know, or outside the body I do not know, God knows—such a one caught up as far as the third heaven.

3 And I know such a man—whether in body or outside the body I do not know, God knows—

4 that he was caught up into paradise and heard unutterable words which it is not permitted for a man to speak.

5 For such a one I will boast, but for myself I will not boast except in my weaknesses.

6 For if I want to boast, I will not be foolish, for I will speak truth; but I refrain, lest someone reckon concerning me beyond what he sees me to be or hears anything from me.

7 And because of the excess of the revelations, so that I may not exalt myself beyond measure, a thorn in the flesh was given to me, a messenger of Satan, to strike me, so that I may not exalt myself beyond measure.

8 Concerning this I urged the Lord three times that it might depart from me.

9 And he has said to me, “My grace suffices for you, for my power is perfected in weakness.” Therefore most gladly I will rather boast in my weaknesses, so that Christ's power may dwell upon me.

10 Therefore I am pleased in weaknesses, in insults, in necessities, in persecutions, in distresses for Christ; for when I am weak, then I am powerful.

11 I have become foolish in boasting; you compelled me. For I ought to have been commended by you, for I lacked nothing of the exceedingly great apostles, even if I am nothing.

12 Indeed the signs of the apostle were worked among you in all endurance, in signs and wonders and powers.

13 For what is there in which you were made inferior to the other churches, except that I myself did not burden you? Forgive me this injustice.

14 Look, a third time I am ready to come to you, and I will not burden you, for I seek not your things but you; for the children ought not to store up for the parents, but the parents for the children.

15 But most gladly I will spend and be spent completely for your souls, even if, loving you more abundantly, I am loved less.

16 But let it be: I did not burden you, but being cunning, I took you by deceit.

17 Did I exploit you through anyone whom I have sent to you?

18 I urged Titus and sent the brother with him. Did Titus exploit you? Did we not walk in the same spirit? In the same footsteps?

19 Again do you think that we defend ourselves to you? Before God we speak in Christ; but all things, beloved, are for your building up.

20 For I fear lest, coming, I find you not such as I want, and I be found by you such as you do not want; lest there be strifes, jealousies, furies, selfish ambitions, backbitings, whisperings, puffings up, disorders;

21 lest when I come again my God humble me before you, and I mourn many of those who sinned beforehand and did not repent of the impurity and sexual immorality and licentiousness which they practiced.

Chapter 13

1 This third time I come to you. Upon the mouth of two witnesses and three every word will stand.

2 I have said beforehand and say beforehand, as present the second time, and absent now I write to those who sinned beforehand and all the rest, that if I come again I will not spare,

3 since you seek proof of Christ speaking in me, who is not weak toward you but powerful among you.

4 For even if he was crucified from weakness, yet he lives from God's power; for we too are weak in him, but will live with him from God's power toward you.

5 Test yourselves whether you are in the faith; examine yourselves. Or do you not recognize yourselves, that Jesus Christ is in you, unless perhaps you are disapproved?

6 But I hope that you will know that we are not disapproved.

7 And I pray to God that you do no evil, not so that we may appear approved, but so that you may do the good and we be as disapproved.

8 For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth.

9 For we rejoice when we are weak and you are powerful; and this we also pray, your restoration.

10 For this reason I write these things absent, so that present I may not act severely according to the authority which the Lord gave me for building up and not for pulling down.

11 Finally, brothers, rejoice, be restored, be encouraged, think the same, be at peace, and the God of love and peace will be with you.

12 Greet one another with a holy kiss. All the saints greet you.

13 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ and God's love and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all. Amen.

Galatians

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle not from people nor through a man, but through Jesus Christ and God the Father who raised him from the dead,

2 and all the brothers with me, to the churches of Galatia:

3 grace to you and peace from God the Father and our Lord Jesus Christ,

4 who gave himself for our sins, so that he may rescue us from the present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father,

5 to whom the glory unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

6 I marvel that you so quickly transfer from the one who called you in Christ's grace to a different gospel,

7 which is not another, except that there are some who trouble you and want to overturn Christ's gospel.

8 But even if we or an angel from heaven proclaims a gospel to you contrary to what we proclaimed to you, let him be accursed.

9 As we have said beforehand, now I also say again: if someone proclaims a gospel to you contrary to what you received, let him be accursed.

10 For now do I persuade people or God? Or do I seek to please people? For if I still pleased people, I would not be Christ's slave.

11 But I make known to you, brothers, that the gospel proclaimed by me is not according to man.

12 For neither did I receive it from a man nor was I taught it, but through revelation of Jesus Christ.

13 For you heard my former conduct in Judaism, that exceedingly I persecuted God's church and ravaged it,

14 and advanced in Judaism beyond many contemporaries in my race, being more abundantly zealous for my ancestral traditions.

15 But when God, who set me apart from my mother's womb and called me through his grace, was pleased

16 to reveal his Son in me, so that I may proclaim him among the nations, immediately I did not consult flesh and blood,

17 nor did I go up to Jerusalem to the apostles before me, but went away to Arabia and again returned to Damascus.

18 Then after three years I went up to Jerusalem to visit Peter, and remained with him fifteen days.

19 But I saw no other of the apostles except James the Lord's brother.

20 And what I write to you, look, before God, I do not lie.

21 Then I came to the regions of Syria and Cilicia.

22 But I was unknown by face to the churches of Judea in Christ,

23 and they were only hearing that “The one formerly persecuting us now proclaims the faith which he formerly ravaged,”

24 and they glorified God in me.

Chapter 2

1 Then after fourteen years I again went up to Jerusalem with Barnabas, also taking Titus along.

2 And I went up according to revelation, and set before them the gospel which I preach among the nations, but privately to those of repute, lest I run or ran in vain.

3 But not even Titus with me, being Greek, was compelled to be circumcised,

4 but because of the false brothers brought in, who slipped in to spy upon our freedom which we have in Christ Jesus, so that they may enslave us,

5 to whom we did not yield in submission even for an hour, so that the truth of the gospel may remain with you.

6 But from those reputed to be something—whatever they once were makes no difference to me; God does not accept a man's face—for those of repute added nothing to me,

7 but on the contrary, seeing that I have been entrusted with the gospel of uncircumcision, just as Peter of circumcision,

8 for the one who worked in Peter for apostleship of circumcision also worked in me for the nations,

9 and knowing the grace given to me, James and Cephas and John, reputed to be pillars, gave right hands of fellowship to me and Barnabas, so that we should go to the nations, but they to circumcision,

10 only that we remember the poor, which very thing I was also diligent to do.

11 But when Peter came to Antioch, I opposed him to his face, because he stood condemned.

12 For before some came from James, he ate together with the nations; but when they came, he withdrew and separated himself, fearing those of circumcision.

13 And the remaining Jews also joined in hypocrisy with him, so that even Barnabas was carried away with their hypocrisy.

14 But when I saw that they did not walk straight toward the truth of the gospel, I said to Peter before all, “If you, being a Jew, live as the nations and not as Jews, why do you compel the nations to live as Jews?

15 We, Jews by nature and not sinners from nations,

16 knowing that a man is not justified from works of law except through faith of Jesus Christ, we too believed in Christ Jesus, so that we may be justified from faith of Christ and not from works of law, because from works of law no flesh will be justified.

17 But if, seeking to be justified in Christ, we ourselves also were found sinners, is Christ then a minister of sin? May it never be!

18 For if I build again the things I tore down, I demonstrate myself a transgressor.

19 For through law I died to law, so that I may live to God.

20 I have been crucified with Christ; and no longer I live, but Christ lives in me; and what I now live in flesh, I live in faith of the Son of God, who loved me and handed himself over for me.

21 I do not reject God's grace; for if righteousness is through law, then Christ died without cause.”

Chapter 3

1 O senseless Galatians, who bewitched you not to obey the truth, before whose eyes Jesus Christ was depicted among you crucified?

2 I want to learn this only from you: did you receive the Spirit from works of law or from hearing of faith?

3 Are you so senseless? Having begun by spirit, are you now completed by flesh?

4 Did you suffer so many things in vain, if indeed even in vain?

5 Therefore the one supplying the Spirit to you and working powers among you, is it from works of law or from hearing of faith?

6 Just as Abraham believed God, and it was reckoned to him as righteousness.

7 Know, then, that those from faith, these are Abraham's sons.

8 And the Scripture, foreseeing that God justifies the nations from faith, proclaimed the gospel beforehand to Abraham, that “All the nations will be blessed in you.”

9 So those from faith are blessed with faithful Abraham.

10 For as many as are from works of law are under a curse; for it is written, “Cursed is everyone who does not remain in all things written in the book of the law, to do them.”

11 And that no one is justified in law before God is clear, because “The righteous one will live from faith.”

12 And the law is not from faith, but “The man who does them will live in them.”

13 Christ bought us out from the curse of the law, becoming a curse for us, for it is written, “Cursed is everyone hanging upon wood,”

14 so that Abraham's blessing may come to the nations in Christ Jesus, so that we may receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.

15 Brothers, I speak according to man: even a man's ratified covenant no one rejects or adds provisions to.

16 And the promises were spoken to Abraham and to his seed. He does not say, “And to seeds,” as concerning many, but as concerning one, “And to your seed,” who is Christ.

17 But I say this: a covenant ratified beforehand by God unto Christ, the law which came four hundred and thirty years later does not invalidate, so as to nullify the promise.

18 For if the inheritance is from law, it is no longer from promise; but God has freely given it to Abraham through promise.

19 What, then, the law? It was added because of transgressions, until the seed should come to whom it has been promised, ordained through angels in a mediator's hand.

20 And the mediator is not of one, but God is one.

21 Is the law, then, against God's promises? May it never be! For if a law was given which could give life, righteousness would indeed have been from law.

22 But the Scripture shut up all things under sin, so that the promise from faith of Jesus Christ may be given to those who believe.

23 But before faith came, we were guarded under law, shut up unto the faith about to be revealed.

24 So the law has become our tutor unto Christ, so that we may be justified from faith.

25 But faith having come, we are no longer under a tutor.

26 For you are all God's sons through faith in Christ Jesus.

27 For as many as were baptized into Christ put on Christ.

28 There is no Jew nor Greek, there is no slave nor free, there is no male and female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus.

29 But if you are Christ's, then you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to promise.

Chapter 4

1 And I say, for as long as the heir is an infant, he differs nothing from a slave, being lord of all,

2 but is under guardians and stewards until the father's appointed time.

3 Thus we too, when we were infants, were enslaved under the world's elements.

4 But when the fullness of time came, God sent out his Son, born from a woman, born under law,

5 so that he may buy out those under law, so that we may receive adoption as sons.

6 And because you are sons, God sent out the Spirit of his Son into your hearts, crying, “Abba, Father.”

7 So you are no longer a slave but a son; and if a son, also God's heir through Christ.

8 But then, not knowing God, you served as slaves to those not being gods by nature.

9 But now, knowing God, or rather being known by God, how do you turn again to the weak and poor elements, to which you want to serve as slaves again anew?

10 You observe days and months and seasons and years.

11 I fear for you, lest I have labored toward you in vain.

12 Become as I, because I too as you, brothers, I petition you. You wronged me in nothing.

13 And you know that because of weakness of the flesh I proclaimed the gospel to you formerly,

14 and my trial in my flesh you did not despise nor spit out, but received me as God's angel, as Christ Jesus.

15 What, then, was your blessedness? For I testify to you that, if possible, having dug out your eyes, you would have given them to me.

16 So have I become your enemy by speaking truth to you?

17 They are zealous for you, not well, but want to exclude you, so that you may be zealous for them.

18 But it is good to be sought zealously in a good thing always, and not only when I am present with you.

19 My little children, for whom I again suffer birth pains until Christ is formed in you,

20 and I wanted to be present with you now and change my voice, because I am perplexed about you.

21 Tell me, you who want to be under law, do you not hear the law?

22 For it is written that Abraham had two sons, one from the slave woman and one from the free woman.

23 But the one from the slave woman has been born according to flesh, and the one from the free woman through the promise.

24 These are being allegorized, for these are the two covenants, one from Mount Sinai, bearing children unto slavery, which is Hagar.

25 For Hagar is Mount Sinai in Arabia, and corresponds to the present Jerusalem, and serves as a slave with her children.

26 But the Jerusalem above is free, which is mother of us all.

27 For it is written, “Rejoice, barren one who does not bear; break forth and cry, you who do not suffer birth pains; because more are the children of the desolate than of the one having the husband.”

28 But we, brothers, according to Isaac, are children of promise.

29 But just as then the one born according to flesh persecuted the one according to spirit, so also now.

30 But what does the Scripture say? “Cast out the slave woman and her son, for the slave woman's son will certainly not inherit with the free woman's son.”

31 Therefore, brothers, we are not children of a slave woman but of the free woman.

Chapter 5

1 Therefore stand in the freedom with which Christ freed us, and do not be held again in a yoke of slavery.

2 Look, I, Paul, say to you that if you are circumcised, Christ will benefit you nothing.

3 And I testify again to every man being circumcised that he is a debtor to do the whole law.

4 You were severed from Christ, you who are justified in law; you fell away from grace.

5 For we by spirit from faith await hope of righteousness.

6 For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision has any strength nor uncircumcision, but faith working through love.

7 You ran well; who hindered you from obeying the truth?

8 The persuasion is not from the one calling you.

9 A little leaven leavens the whole lump.

10 I trust concerning you in the Lord that you will think nothing else; but the one troubling you will carry the judgment, whoever he may be.

11 And I, brothers, if I still preach circumcision, why am I still persecuted? Then the offense of the cross has been nullified.

12 I wish those unsettling you would even cut themselves off.

13 For you were called upon freedom, brothers; only do not make freedom an opportunity for the flesh, but through love serve one another as slaves.

14 For the whole law is fulfilled in one word, in “You shall love your neighbor as yourself.”

15 But if you bite and devour one another, watch lest you be consumed by one another.

16 And I say, walk by spirit, and you will certainly not fulfill desire of flesh.

17 For the flesh desires against the spirit, and the spirit against the flesh; and these oppose one another, so that whatever you want, these things you may not do.

18 But if you are led by spirit, you are not under law.

19 And the works of the flesh are manifest, which are adultery, sexual immorality, impurity, licentiousness,

20 idolatry, sorcery, enmities, strifes, jealousies, furies, selfish ambitions, divisions, factions,

21 envies, murders, drunkenness, revelries, and things like these, which I tell you beforehand, just as I also said beforehand, that those practicing such things will not inherit God's kingdom.

22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faith,

23 gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law.

24 And those of Christ crucified the flesh with the passions and desires.

25 If we live by spirit, let us also walk in line by spirit.

26 Let us not become conceited, provoking one another, envying one another.

Chapter 6

1 Brothers, even if a man is overtaken in some trespass, you who are spiritual restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness, watching yourself lest you too be tempted.

2 Carry one another's burdens, and thus fulfill Christ's law.

3 For if someone thinks to be something, being nothing, he deceives his own mind.

4 But let each examine his own work, and then he will have the boast toward himself only and not toward the other.

5 For each will carry his own load.

6 And let the one instructed in the word share in all good things with the one instructing.

7 Do not be deceived; God is not mocked, for whatever a man sows, this he will also reap.

8 Because the one sowing unto his own flesh will reap corruption from the flesh, but the one sowing unto the Spirit will reap eternal life from the Spirit.

9 And doing the good, let us not lose heart, for in its own time we will reap, not giving up.

10 So then, as we have time, let us work the good toward all, and especially toward the household of faith.

11 See with how large letters I wrote to you with my own hand.

12 As many as want to make a good showing in flesh, these compel you to be circumcised, only so that they may not be persecuted for Christ's cross.

13 For neither do those being circumcised themselves keep law, but want you to be circumcised so that they may boast in your flesh.

14 But may it never be for me to boast except in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom a world has been crucified to me and I to a world.

15 For in Christ Jesus neither circumcision has any strength nor uncircumcision, but a new creation.

16 And as many as will walk in line by this rule, peace upon them and mercy, and upon God's Israel.

17 Henceforth let no one cause me troubles, for I carry the marks of the Lord Jesus in my body.

18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit, brothers. Amen.

Ephesians

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ through God's will, to the saints who are in Ephesus and faithful in Christ Jesus:

2 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 Blessed is the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who blessed us with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly places in Christ,

4 just as he chose us in him before the foundation of a world, for us to be holy and blameless before him in love,

5 having predestined us unto adoption as sons through Jesus Christ unto himself, according to the good pleasure of his will,

6 unto praise of the glory of his grace, in which he graced us in the beloved one,

7 in whom we have redemption through his blood, forgiveness of trespasses, according to the riches of his grace,

8 which he made abound toward us in all wisdom and understanding,

9 having made known to us the mystery of his will, according to his good pleasure which he purposed in him,

10 for a stewardship of the fullness of the times, to sum up all things in Christ, both the things in the heavens and those upon earth,

11 in him, in whom we also received an allotted inheritance, predestined according to the purpose of the one working all things according to the counsel of his will,

12 for us to be unto praise of his glory, who have hoped beforehand in Christ,

13 in whom you too, having heard the word of truth, the gospel of your salvation, in whom also having believed, were sealed with the Holy Spirit of promise,

14 who is a pledge of our inheritance, unto redemption of the possession, unto praise of his glory.

15 For this reason I too, having heard your faith in the Lord Jesus and the love toward all the saints,

16 do not cease giving thanks for you, making mention of you in my prayers,

17 so that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of glory, may give you a spirit of wisdom and revelation in knowledge of him,

18 the eyes of your understanding having been illuminated, so that you may know what is the hope of his calling, and what the riches of the glory of his inheritance among the saints,

19 and what the surpassing greatness of his power toward us who believe, according to the working of the might of his strength,

20 which he worked in Christ, raising him from the dead, and seated him at his right hand in the heavenly places,

21 far above every rule and authority and power and lordship and every name named, not only in this age but also in the coming one,

22 and subjected all things under his feet, and gave him as head over all things to the church,

23 which is his body, the fullness of the one filling all things in all.

Chapter 2

1 And you, being dead in trespasses and sins,

2 in which you once walked according to the age of this world, according to the ruler of the authority of the air, of the spirit now working in the sons of disobedience,

3 among whom we all also once conducted ourselves in the desires of our flesh, doing the wills of the flesh and the thoughts, and were by nature children of wrath, as also the rest;

4 but God, being rich in mercy, because of his great love with which he loved us,

5 even when we were dead in trespasses, made us alive together with Christ—by grace you have been saved—

6 and raised us together and seated us together in the heavenly places in Christ Jesus,

7 so that in the coming ages he may demonstrate the surpassing riches of his grace in kindness toward us in Christ Jesus.

8 For by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from you, God's gift,

9 not from works, so that no one may boast.

10 For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works which God prepared beforehand, so that we may walk in them.

11 Therefore remember that you once were the nations in flesh, called uncircumcision by the so-called circumcision in flesh made by hands,

12 that at that time you were apart from Christ, alienated from Israel's citizenship and strangers to the covenants of promise, having no hope and godless in the world.

13 But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far became near in Christ's blood.

14 For he himself is our peace, who made both one and broke down the middle wall of the barrier,

15 the enmity in his flesh, nullifying the law of commandments in decrees, so that he may create the two in himself into one new man, making peace,

16 and reconcile both in one body to God through the cross, killing the enmity in it.

17 And coming, he proclaimed peace to you who were far and to those near,

18 because through him we both have access in one Spirit to the Father.

19 So then you are no longer strangers and resident aliens, but fellow citizens of the saints and God's household,

20 built upon the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ himself being the cornerstone,

21 in whom the whole building, fitted together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord,

22 in whom you too are built together into God's dwelling in spirit.

Chapter 3

1 For this reason I, Paul, the prisoner of Christ Jesus for you, the nations—

2 if indeed you heard the stewardship of God's grace given to me for you,

3 that according to revelation he made the mystery known to me, just as I wrote beforehand briefly,

4 by which, reading, you can understand my comprehension in Christ's mystery,

5 which in other generations was not made known to the sons of people as it has now been revealed to his holy apostles and prophets in spirit,

6 that the nations are fellow heirs and of the same body and fellow sharers of his promise in Christ through the gospel,

7 of which I became a minister according to the gift of God's grace given to me according to the working of his power.

8 To me, less than the least of all saints, this grace was given, to proclaim among the nations the untraceable riches of Christ,

9 and illuminate all as to what is the fellowship of the mystery hidden from the ages in God who created all things through Jesus Christ,

10 so that now God's manifold wisdom may be made known to the rulers and authorities in the heavenly places through the church,

11 according to the purpose of the ages which he made in Christ Jesus our Lord,

12 in whom we have boldness and access in confidence through his faith.

13 Therefore I ask not to lose heart in my afflictions for you, which are your glory.

14 For this reason I bend my knees to the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,

15 from whom every family in heavens and upon earth is named,

16 so that he may give you, according to the riches of his glory, to be strengthened with power through his Spirit unto the inner man,

17 for Christ to dwell through faith in your hearts,

18 rooted and founded in love, so that you may have strength to grasp with all the saints what is the breadth and length and depth and height,

19 and to know Christ's love surpassing knowledge, so that you may be filled unto all God's fullness.

20 And to the one able to do above all things, exceedingly beyond what we ask or think, according to the power working in us,

21 to him the glory in the church in Christ Jesus unto all generations of the age of the ages. Amen.

Chapter 4

1 Therefore I, the prisoner in the Lord, urge you to walk worthily of the calling with which you were called,

2 with all humility and gentleness, with patience, bearing with one another in love,

3 being diligent to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.

4 One body and one Spirit, just as you were also called in one hope of your calling;

5 one Lord, one faith, one baptism;

6 one God and Father of all, who is over all and through all and in you all.

7 But to each one of us grace was given according to the measure of Christ's gift.

8 Therefore he says, “Ascending into height, he took captivity captive, and gave gifts to people.”

9 And “He ascended,” what is it except that he also first descended into the lower parts of the earth?

10 The one descending is himself also the one ascending far above all the heavens, so that he may fill all things.

11 And he himself gave some as apostles, some as prophets, some as evangelists, some as shepherds and teachers,

12 for the fitting of the saints, unto work of ministry, unto building up Christ's body,

13 until we all attain the unity of faith and knowledge of God's Son, unto a mature man, unto a measure of stature of Christ's fullness,

14 so that we may no longer be infants, tossed by waves and carried around by every wind of teaching, in people's trickery, in cunning toward the scheming of error,

15 but speaking truth in love, may grow in all things unto him who is the head, Christ,

16 from whom the whole body, fitted together and joined together through every joint of supply, according to working in the measure of each single part, makes the growth of the body unto building itself up in love.

17 Therefore I say this and testify in the Lord, that you no longer walk as also the remaining nations walk in the futility of their mind,

18 being darkened in understanding, alienated from God's life because of the ignorance within them, because of the hardness of their heart,

19 who, having become insensible, handed themselves over to licentiousness for the working of every impurity in greed.

20 But you did not thus learn Christ,

21 if indeed you heard him and were taught in him, just as truth is in Jesus,

22 for you to put off, according to the former conduct, the old man being corrupted according to the desires of deceit,

23 and to be renewed in the spirit of your mind,

24 and put on the new man created according to God in righteousness and holiness of truth.

25 Therefore, having put off the lie, speak truth, each with his neighbor, because we are members of one another.

26 Be angry and do not sin; do not let the sun set upon your provocation,

27 nor give place to the devil.

28 Let the one stealing no longer steal, but rather labor, working the good with the hands, so that he may have to share with the one having need.

29 Let no rotten word go out from your mouth, but if there is a good one for building up the need, so that it may give grace to those hearing.

30 And do not grieve God's Holy Spirit, in whom you were sealed unto a day of redemption.

31 Let all bitterness and fury and wrath and shouting and slander be taken away from you with all malice.

32 And become kind toward one another, compassionate, forgiving one another, just as God also in Christ forgave you.

Chapter 5

1 Therefore become imitators of God as beloved children,

2 and walk in love, just as Christ also loved us and handed himself over for us, an offering and sacrifice to God unto an odor of fragrance.

3 But sexual immorality and every impurity or greed, let it not even be named among you, as is fitting for saints,

4 and shamefulness and foolish speech or coarse jesting, things not fitting, but rather thanksgiving.

5 For you know this, that every sexually immoral or unclean or greedy one, who is an idolater, has no inheritance in the kingdom of Christ and God.

6 Let no one deceive you with empty words, for because of these things God's wrath comes upon the sons of disobedience.

7 Therefore do not become fellow sharers with them.

8 For you once were darkness, but now light in the Lord; walk as children of light,

9 for the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness and righteousness and truth,

10 examining what is pleasing to the Lord,

11 and do not share together in the fruitless works of darkness, but rather also expose them.

12 For the things done secretly by them are shameful even to speak of.

13 But all things exposed are manifested by the light, for everything manifested is light.

14 Therefore he says, “Awake, sleeper, and rise from the dead, and Christ will shine upon you.”

15 Therefore watch how carefully you walk, not as unwise but as wise,

16 buying out the time, because the days are evil.

17 For this reason do not become foolish, but understanding what the Lord's will is.

18 And do not become drunk with wine, in which is dissipation, but be filled in spirit,

19 speaking to one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody in your heart to the Lord,

20 always giving thanks for all things in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ to God and Father,

21 submitting to one another in God's fear.

22 Wives, submit to your own husbands as to the Lord,

23 because the husband is head of the wife, as also Christ head of the church, and he himself is savior of the body.

24 But just as the church submits to Christ, so also the wives to their own husbands in everything.

25 Husbands, love your own wives, just as Christ also loved the church and handed himself over for her,

26 so that he may sanctify her, cleansing her with the washing of water in a word,

27 so that he may present her to himself as the glorious church, not having spot or wrinkle or anything of such things, but so that she may be holy and blameless.

28 Thus husbands ought to love their own wives as their own bodies. The one loving his own wife loves himself.

29 For no one ever hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, just as the Lord also the church,

30 because we are members of his body, from his flesh and from his bones.

31 For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and join himself to his wife, and the two will be one flesh.

32 This mystery is great, but I speak unto Christ and unto the church.

33 Nevertheless, you too individually, let each thus love his own wife as himself, and the wife fear the husband.

Chapter 6

1 Children, obey your parents in the Lord, for this is righteous.

2 “Honor your father and mother,” which is the first commandment with a promise,

3 “so that it may be well with you and you may be long-lived upon the earth.”

4 And fathers, do not provoke your children to anger, but nourish them in the Lord's discipline and admonition.

5 Slaves, obey the lords according to flesh with fear and trembling, in simplicity of your heart, as Christ,

6 not according to eye-service as people-pleasers, but as Christ's slaves, doing God's will from the soul,

7 serving as slaves with goodwill to the Lord and not to people,

8 knowing that whatever good each does, this he will receive from the Lord, whether slave or free.

9 And lords, do the same toward them, giving up the threat, knowing that your own Lord also is in heavens, and there is no partiality with him.

10 Finally, my brothers, be empowered in the Lord and in the might of his strength.

11 Put on God's full armor, so that you may be able to stand against the devil's schemes,

12 because our wrestling is not against blood and flesh, but against the rulers, against the authorities, against the world-rulers of the darkness of this age, against the spiritual things of wickedness in the heavenly places.

13 For this reason take up God's full armor, so that you may be able to withstand on the evil day, and having worked everything, to stand.

14 Therefore stand, having girded your waist in truth and put on the breastplate of righteousness,

15 and shod your feet in readiness of the gospel of peace,

16 above all taking up the shield of faith, in which you will be able to quench all the burning arrows of the evil one,

17 and receive the helmet of salvation and the Spirit's sword, which is God's word,

18 through every prayer and petition, praying at every time in spirit, and keeping watch unto this very thing in all perseverance and petition concerning all the saints,

19 and for me, so that a word may be given me in opening my mouth, in boldness to make known the mystery of the gospel,

20 for which I act as ambassador in a chain, so that in it I may speak boldly as I ought to speak.

21 And so that you too may know the things concerning me, what I practice, Tychicus the beloved brother and faithful minister in the Lord will make all things known to you,

22 whom I sent to you for this very thing, so that you may know the things concerning us and he may encourage your hearts.

23 Peace to the brothers and love with faith from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

24 Grace be with all who love our Lord Jesus Christ in incorruptibility. Amen.

Philippians

Chapter 1

1 Paul and Timothy, slaves of Jesus Christ, to all the saints in Christ Jesus in Philippi, with overseers and ministers:

2 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 I thank my God at every remembrance of you,

4 always in every petition of mine for you all, making the petition with joy,

5 for your fellowship unto the gospel from the first day until now,

6 trusting this very thing, that the one who began a good work in you will complete it until Jesus Christ's day.

7 Just as it is righteous for me to think this for you all, because I have you in my heart, both in my bonds and in the defense and confirmation of the gospel, you all being my fellow sharers of grace.

8 For God is my witness, how I long for you all in Jesus Christ's inward affections.

9 And this I pray, that your love may abound still more and more in knowledge and all perception,

10 for you to discern the things that differ, so that you may be sincere and without offense unto Christ's day,

11 filled with fruits of righteousness through Jesus Christ, unto God's glory and praise.

12 But I want you to know, brothers, that the things concerning me have rather come unto the gospel's advancement,

13 so that my bonds became manifest in Christ in the whole praetorium and to all the rest,

14 and most of the brothers in the Lord, trusting through my bonds, dare more abundantly to speak the word fearlessly.

15 Some indeed preach Christ even because of envy and strife, but some also because of goodwill.

16 These proclaim Christ from selfish ambition, not purely, thinking to bring affliction upon my bonds,

17 but those from love, knowing that I am set for defense of the gospel.

18 For what? Except that in every way, whether in pretense or truth, Christ is proclaimed, and in this I rejoice; but I will also rejoice.

19 For I know that this will turn out for me unto salvation through your petition and supply of Jesus Christ's Spirit,

20 according to my eager expectation and hope, that in nothing I will be shamed, but in all boldness, as always, now also Christ will be magnified in my body, whether through life or through death.

21 For to me, to live is Christ and to die gain.

22 But if to live in flesh, this is fruit of work for me, and what I will choose I do not make known.

23 For I am constrained by the two, having the desire to depart and be with Christ, much more better,

24 but to remain in the flesh is more necessary because of you.

25 And trusting this, I know that I will remain and stay with you all for your advancement and joy of faith,

26 so that your boast may abound in Christ Jesus in me through my presence again with you.

27 Only conduct yourselves as citizens worthily of Christ's gospel, so that whether coming and seeing you or absent, I may hear the things concerning you, that you stand in one spirit, with one soul striving together for the faith of the gospel,

28 and frightened in nothing by the opponents, which is to them a demonstration of destruction, but to you of salvation, and this from God,

29 because to you was freely given, for Christ, not only to believe in him but also to suffer for him,

30 having the same struggle as you saw in me and now hear in me.

Chapter 2

1 Therefore, if any encouragement in Christ, if any consolation of love, if any fellowship of spirit, if any inward affections and compassions,

2 fulfill my joy, that you think the same, having the same love, united in soul, thinking the one thing,

3 nothing according to selfish ambition or conceit, but in humility considering one another above yourselves,

4 each looking not to your own things but each also to others' things.

5 For let this be thought among you which was also in Christ Jesus,

6 who, being in God's form, did not consider being equal to God a seizure,

7 but emptied himself, taking a slave's form, becoming in people's likeness,

8 and being found in appearance as a man, humbled himself, becoming obedient until death, and death of a cross.

9 Therefore God also exalted him beyond measure and freely gave him a name above every name,

10 so that in Jesus's name every knee may bend, of heavenly and earthly and subterranean beings,

11 and every tongue confess that Jesus Christ is Lord, unto God the Father's glory.

12 So, my beloved, just as you always obeyed, not as in my presence only, but now much more in my absence, work out your own salvation with fear and trembling.

13 For God is the one working in you both the willing and the working for the good pleasure.

14 Do everything without grumblings and reasonings,

15 so that you may become blameless and unmixed, God's children without blemish in the midst of a crooked and distorted generation, among whom you appear as luminaries in a world,

16 holding forth a word of life, for a boast to me unto Christ's day, that I did not run in vain nor labor in vain.

17 But even if I am poured out upon the sacrifice and service of your faith, I rejoice and rejoice together with you all.

18 And the same, you too rejoice and rejoice together with me.

19 And I hope in the Lord Jesus to send Timothy quickly to you, so that I too may be heartened, knowing the things concerning you.

20 For I have no one of equal soul who will genuinely care for the things concerning you,

21 for all seek their own things, not those of Christ Jesus.

22 But you know his proven character, that as a child with a father he served as a slave with me unto the gospel.

23 Therefore I hope to send this one immediately, whenever I see the things concerning me,

24 and I trust in the Lord that I myself also will come quickly.

25 But I considered it necessary to send to you Epaphroditus, my brother and fellow worker and fellow soldier, but your apostle and servant of my need,

26 since he was longing for you all and distressed because you heard that he was sick.

27 For indeed he was sick near death; but God had mercy on him, and not him only but also me, so that I might not have grief upon grief.

28 Therefore I sent him more diligently, so that seeing him you may rejoice again and I be less grieved.

29 Therefore receive him in the Lord with all joy, and hold such people in honor,

30 because for Christ's work he drew near until death, risking his life so that he may fill up your lack of service toward me.

Chapter 3

1 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord. To write the same things to you is not tedious for me, but safe for you.

2 Watch the dogs, watch the evil workers, watch the mutilation.

3 For we are the circumcision, who serve God in spirit and boast in Christ Jesus and do not trust in flesh,

4 though I also have confidence in flesh. If someone else thinks to trust in flesh, I more:

5 circumcision on the eighth day, from Israel's race, of Benjamin's tribe, a Hebrew from Hebrews, according to law a Pharisee,

6 according to zeal persecuting the church, according to righteousness in law having become blameless.

7 But whatever things were gains to me, these I have considered loss because of Christ.

8 But indeed I also consider everything to be loss because of the surpassing knowledge of Christ Jesus my Lord, because of whom I suffered loss of all things, and consider them refuse so that I may gain Christ,

9 and be found in him, not having my own righteousness from law, but that through faith of Christ, the righteousness from God upon faith,

10 to know him and the power of his resurrection and fellowship of his sufferings, being conformed to his death,

11 if somehow I may attain the resurrection from the dead.

12 Not that I already received or have already been perfected, but I pursue, if I may also grasp that for which I was also grasped by Christ Jesus.

13 Brothers, I do not reckon myself to have grasped it; but one thing, forgetting the things behind and stretching toward those before,

14 I pursue according to the goal for the prize of God's upward calling in Christ Jesus.

15 Therefore, as many as are mature, let us think this; and if you think anything differently, God will also reveal this to you.

16 Nevertheless, unto what we attained, walk in line by the same rule, think the same thing.

17 Become fellow imitators of me, brothers, and watch those walking thus, just as you have us as a pattern.

18 For many walk, of whom I often told you, but now also weeping say, the enemies of Christ's cross,

19 whose end is destruction, whose god the belly and glory in their shame, who mind earthly things.

20 For our citizenship is in heavens, from which we also await a savior, the Lord Jesus Christ,

21 who will transform the body of our humiliation, for it to become conformed to the body of his glory, according to the working of his ability also to subject all things to himself.

Chapter 4

1 So, my beloved and longed-for brothers, my joy and crown, stand thus in the Lord, beloved.

2 I urge Euodia and urge Syntyche to think the same in the Lord.

3 And I ask you also, genuine yokefellow, help them, who strove together with me in the gospel, also with Clement and my remaining fellow workers, whose names are in a book of life.

4 Rejoice in the Lord always; again I will say, rejoice.

5 Let your fairness be known to all people. The Lord is near.

6 Be anxious about nothing, but in everything by prayer and petition with thanksgiving let your requests be made known to God.

7 And God's peace, surpassing every mind, will guard your hearts and thoughts in Christ Jesus.

8 Finally, brothers, whatever things are true, whatever dignified, whatever righteous, whatever pure, whatever lovable, whatever well spoken of, if any virtue and if any praise, reckon these things.

9 What you also learned and received and heard and saw in me, practice these things, and the God of peace will be with you.

10 And I rejoiced greatly in the Lord, that now at last you revived your thinking for me, about which you also were thinking, but lacked opportunity.

11 Not that I speak according to lack, for I learned to be sufficient in the things in which I am.

12 And I know to be humbled, and know to abound; in everything and in all things I have been initiated both to be filled and to hunger, both to abound and to lack.

13 I have strength for all things in Christ who empowers me.

14 Nevertheless you did well, sharing together in my affliction.

15 And you too know, Philippians, that at the beginning of the gospel, when I went out from Macedonia, no church shared with me in an account of giving and receiving except you alone,

16 because even in Thessalonica you sent both once and twice for my need.

17 Not that I seek the gift, but I seek the fruit increasing unto your account.

18 But I have received everything and abound; I have been filled, receiving from Epaphroditus the things from you, an odor of fragrance, an acceptable sacrifice, pleasing to God.

19 And my God will fill every need of yours according to his riches in glory in Christ Jesus.

20 And to our God and Father the glory unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

21 Greet every saint in Christ Jesus. The brothers with me greet you.

22 All the saints greet you, and especially those of Caesar's household.

23 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

Colossians

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ through God's will, and Timothy the brother,

2 to the saints and faithful brothers in Christ in Colossae: grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 We thank the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, always praying concerning you,

4 having heard your faith in Christ Jesus and the love toward all the saints,

5 because of the hope laid away for you in the heavens, which you heard beforehand in the word of the truth of the gospel,

6 which is present with you, just as also in all the world, and is bearing fruit, just as also among you from the day you heard and fully knew God's grace in truth,

7 just as you also learned from Epaphras our beloved fellow slave, who is a faithful minister of Christ for you,

8 who also made clear to us your love in spirit.

9 For this reason we too, from the day we heard, do not cease praying for you and asking that you may be filled with knowledge of his will in all spiritual wisdom and understanding,

10 for you to walk worthily of the Lord unto all pleasing, bearing fruit in every good work and growing unto knowledge of God,

11 empowered with all power according to the might of his glory, unto all endurance and patience with joy,

12 giving thanks to the Father who made us fit for the portion of the inheritance of the saints in the light,

13 who rescued us from the authority of darkness and transferred us into the kingdom of the Son of his love,

14 in whom we have redemption through his blood, forgiveness of sins,

15 who is an image of the invisible God, firstborn of all creation,

16 because in him all things were created, those in the heavens and those upon earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or lordships or rulers or authorities; all things have been created through him and unto him,

17 and he is before all things, and all things have held together in him,

18 and he is the head of the body, the church, who is beginning, firstborn from the dead, so that he may become first in all things,

19 because in him all the fullness was pleased to dwell,

20 and through him to reconcile all things unto him, making peace through the blood of his cross, through him, whether the things upon earth or those in the heavens.

21 And you, once being alienated and enemies in thought in evil works, but now he reconciled,

22 in the body of his flesh through death, to present you holy and blameless and unaccused before him,

23 if indeed you remain in faith, founded and firm, and not moved away from the hope of the gospel which you heard, proclaimed in all creation under heaven, of which I, Paul, became a minister.

24 Now I rejoice in my sufferings for you, and fill up in turn the lacks of Christ's afflictions in my flesh for his body, which is the church,

25 of which I became a minister according to God's stewardship given to me for you, to fulfill God's word,

26 the mystery hidden from the ages and from the generations, but now manifested to his saints,

27 to whom God wanted to make known what are the riches of the glory of this mystery among the nations, which is Christ in you, the hope of glory,

28 whom we proclaim, admonishing every man and teaching every man in all wisdom, so that we may present every man mature in Christ Jesus,

29 for which I also labor, struggling according to his working which works in me in power.

Chapter 2

1 For I want you to know how great a struggle I have concerning you and those in Laodicea and as many as have not seen my face in flesh,

2 so that their hearts may be encouraged, being joined together in love and unto all riches of the full assurance of understanding, unto knowledge of the mystery of God and Father and of Christ,

3 in whom all the treasures of wisdom and knowledge are hidden.

4 And I say this so that no one may deceive you with persuasive speech.

5 For even if I am absent in flesh, yet in spirit I am with you, rejoicing and seeing your order and the firmness of your faith toward Christ.

6 Therefore, as you received Christ Jesus the Lord, walk in him,

7 rooted and built upon in him and confirmed in the faith, just as you were taught, abounding in it in thanksgiving.

8 Watch lest there be someone carrying you off as spoil through philosophy and empty deceit, according to people's tradition, according to the world's elements and not according to Christ,

9 because in him all the fullness of deity dwells bodily,

10 and you have been filled in him, who is the head of every rule and authority,

11 in whom you were also circumcised with a circumcision not made by hands, in the stripping off of the body of the sins of the flesh, in Christ's circumcision,

12 buried together with him in baptism, in which you were also raised together through faith of the working of God who raised him from the dead.

13 And you, being dead in trespasses and the uncircumcision of your flesh, he made alive together with him, forgiving us all the trespasses,

14 wiping out the handwritten document against us in decrees, which was opposed to us, and he has taken it out of the midst, nailing it to the cross,

15 stripping off the rulers and authorities, he displayed them in boldness, triumphing over them in it.

16 Therefore let no one judge you in eating or drinking or in respect of a feast or new moon or sabbaths,

17 which are a shadow of the coming things, but the body is Christ's.

18 Let no one disqualify you, wanting in humility and worship of angels, entering into things he has not seen, vainly puffed up by the mind of his flesh,

19 and not holding the head, from whom the whole body, supplied and joined together through joints and bonds, grows with God's growth.

20 Therefore, if you died with Christ from the world's elements, why, as living in a world, are you subjected to decrees,

21 “Do not handle, nor taste, nor touch,”

22 which are all unto corruption through use, according to people's commandments and teachings?

23 These indeed have an appearance of wisdom in self-chosen worship and humility and unsparing treatment of body, not in any honor toward satisfaction of the flesh.

Chapter 3

1 Therefore, if you were raised together with Christ, seek the things above, where Christ is, seated at God's right hand.

2 Mind the things above, not those upon earth,

3 for you died, and your life has been hidden with Christ in God.

4 When Christ, our life, is manifested, then you too will be manifested with him in glory.

5 Therefore put to death your members upon earth: sexual immorality, impurity, passion, evil desire, and greed, which is idolatry,

6 because of which God's wrath comes upon the sons of disobedience,

7 in which you too once walked, when you lived in them.

8 But now you too put off everything: wrath, fury, malice, slander, shameful speech from your mouth.

9 Do not lie to one another, having stripped off the old man with his practices,

10 and put on the new, renewed unto knowledge according to the image of the one who created him,

11 where there is no Greek and Jew, circumcision and uncircumcision, barbarian, Scythian, slave, free, but Christ all things and in all.

12 Therefore put on, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, inward affections of compassion, kindness, humility, gentleness, patience,

13 bearing with one another and forgiving one another, if someone has a complaint against someone; just as Christ also forgave you, so you too.

14 And above all these, love, which is the bond of perfection.

15 And let God's peace arbitrate in your hearts, unto which you were also called in one body, and become thankful.

16 Let Christ's word dwell in you richly, in all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another, in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, in grace singing in your heart to the Lord.

17 And everything, whatever you do in word or deed, all in the Lord Jesus's name, giving thanks to God and Father through him.

18 Wives, submit to your own husbands, as was fitting in the Lord.

19 Husbands, love the wives and do not be embittered toward them.

20 Children, obey the parents in everything, for this is pleasing to the Lord.

21 Fathers, do not provoke your children, so that they may not lose heart.

22 Slaves, obey in everything the lords according to flesh, not in eye-services as people-pleasers, but in simplicity of heart, fearing God.

23 And everything, whatever you do, work from the soul, as to the Lord and not to people,

24 knowing that from the Lord you will receive the recompense of the inheritance, for you serve as slaves to the Lord Christ.

25 But the one wronging will receive what he wronged, and there is no partiality.

Chapter 4

1 Lords, provide the righteous thing and equality to the slaves, knowing that you too have a Lord in heavens.

2 Persevere in prayer, keeping watch in it in thanksgiving,

3 praying together also concerning us, so that God may open to us a door of the word, to speak Christ's mystery, because of which I have also been bound,

4 so that I may manifest it as I ought to speak.

5 Walk in wisdom toward those outside, buying out the time.

6 Let your word always be in grace, seasoned with salt, to know how you ought to answer each one.

7 Tychicus, the beloved brother and faithful minister and fellow slave in the Lord, will make known to you all the things concerning me,

8 whom I sent to you for this very thing, so that he may know the things concerning you and encourage your hearts,

9 with Onesimus the faithful and beloved brother, who is from you. They will make known to you all the things here.

10 Aristarchus my fellow captive greets you, and Mark, Barnabas's cousin, concerning whom you received commands: if he comes to you, receive him,

11 and Jesus called Justus, who are of circumcision. These alone are fellow workers unto God's kingdom, who became consolation to me.

12 Epaphras, who is from you, Christ's slave, greets you, always struggling for you in prayers, so that you may stand mature and filled in every will of God.

13 For I testify to him that he has much zeal for you and those in Laodicea and those in Hierapolis.

14 Luke the beloved physician greets you, and Demas.

15 Greet the brothers in Laodicea, and Nymphas and the church in his house.

16 And when the letter is read among you, make it also be read in the church of the Laodiceans, and you too read the one from Laodicea.

17 And say to Archippus, “Watch the ministry which you received in the Lord, so that you may fulfill it.”

18 The greeting by my own hand, Paul's. Remember my bonds. Grace be with you. Amen.

1 Thessalonians

Chapter 1

1 Paul and Silvanus and Timothy, to the church of Thessalonians in God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ: grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

2 We thank God always concerning you all, making mention of you in our prayers,

3 unceasingly remembering your work of faith and labor of love and endurance of hope of our Lord Jesus Christ, before our God and Father,

4 knowing, brothers beloved by God, your choice,

5 because our gospel came to you not in word only, but also in power and in the Holy Spirit and in much full assurance, just as you know what sort we became among you because of you.

6 And you became imitators of us and of the Lord, receiving the word in much affliction with joy of the Holy Spirit,

7 so that you became patterns to all those believing in Macedonia and Achaia.

8 For from you the Lord's word has sounded out, not only in Macedonia and Achaia, but also in every place your faith toward God has gone out, so that we have no need to speak anything.

9 For they themselves report concerning us what sort of entrance we have to you, and how you turned to God from the idols to serve as slaves to a living and true God,

10 and await his Son from the heavens, whom he raised from the dead, Jesus who rescues us from the coming wrath.

Chapter 2

1 For you yourselves know, brothers, our entrance to you, that it has not become empty,

2 but even having suffered beforehand and been insulted, as you know, in Philippi, we were bold in our God to speak God's gospel to you in much struggle.

3 For our exhortation is not from error nor from impurity nor in deceit,

4 but just as we have been approved by God to be entrusted with the gospel, so we speak, not as pleasing people but God who examines our hearts.

5 For neither did we ever come in a word of flattery, as you know, nor in a pretext of greed, God is witness,

6 nor seeking glory from people, neither from you nor from others, being able to be a burden as Christ's apostles.

7 But we became gentle in your midst, as a nurse cherishes her own children.

8 Thus yearning for you, we were pleased to share with you not only God's gospel but also our own souls, because you have become beloved to us.

9 For you remember, brothers, our labor and toil, for working night and day so as not to burden any of you, we preached God's gospel to you.

10 You are witnesses, and God, how holily and righteously and blamelessly we became toward you who believe,

11 just as you know how, as a father his own children, we encouraged each one of you and consoled you,

12 and testified, for you to walk worthily of God who calls you into his own kingdom and glory.

13 For this reason we too thank God unceasingly, because receiving a word of hearing from us, of God, you accepted not a word of people but, just as it truly is, God's word, which also works in you who believe.

14 For you became imitators, brothers, of God's churches in Judea in Christ Jesus, because you too suffered the same things from your own countrymen as they also from the Jews,

15 who both killed the Lord Jesus and their own prophets and drove you out, and do not please God and are opposed to all people,

16 preventing us from speaking to the nations so that they may be saved, to fill up their sins always; but wrath came upon them unto the end.

17 But we, brothers, orphaned from you for an hour's time, in face, not heart, were more abundantly diligent to see your face in much desire.

18 Therefore we wanted to come to you, I, Paul, both once and twice, and Satan hindered us.

19 For what is our hope or joy or crown of boasting? Or is it not also you before our Lord Jesus Christ at his coming?

20 For you are our glory and joy.

Chapter 3

1 Therefore, no longer bearing it, we were pleased to be left in Athens alone,

2 and sent Timothy, our brother and God's minister and our fellow worker in Christ's gospel, to strengthen you and encourage you concerning your faith,

3 so that no one be shaken in these afflictions, for you yourselves know that we are appointed to this.

4 For also when we were with you, we told you beforehand that we were about to be afflicted, just as it also happened and you know.

5 For this reason I too, no longer bearing it, sent to know your faith, lest the tempter tempted you and our labor become empty.

6 But now Timothy having come to us from you and brought us good news of your faith and love, and that you have good remembrance of us always, longing to see us just as we also you,

7 for this reason we were encouraged, brothers, over you in all our affliction and necessity through your faith,

8 because now we live, if you stand in the Lord.

9 For what thanksgiving can we repay to God concerning you for all the joy with which we rejoice because of you before our God,

10 night and day petitioning exceedingly to see your face and fit the lacks of your faith?

11 And may our God and Father himself and our Lord Jesus Christ direct our way to you.

12 And may the Lord make you increase and abound in love toward one another and toward all, just as we also toward you,

13 to strengthen your hearts blameless in holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ with all his saints.

Chapter 4

1 Finally, therefore, brothers, we ask you and urge you in the Lord Jesus, just as you received from us how you ought to walk and please God, that you abound more.

2 For you know what commands we gave you through the Lord Jesus.

3 For this is God's will, your sanctification, for you to abstain from sexual immorality,

4 for each of you to know how to acquire his own vessel in sanctification and honor,

5 not in passion of desire, just as also the nations who do not know God,

6 not to overstep and exploit his brother in the matter, because the Lord is an avenger concerning all these things, just as we also told you beforehand and solemnly testified.

7 For God did not call us upon impurity but in sanctification.

8 Therefore the one rejecting rejects not a man but God, who also gave his Holy Spirit unto us.

9 And concerning brotherly love, you have no need for writing to you, for you yourselves are taught by God to love one another,

10 for also you do it toward all the brothers in all Macedonia; but we urge you, brothers, to abound more,

11 and aspire to be quiet and practice your own affairs and work with your own hands, just as we commanded you,

12 so that you may walk decently toward those outside and have need of no one.

13 But I do not want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning those who have fallen asleep, so that you may not grieve as also the rest who have no hope.

14 For if we believe that Jesus died and rose, so also God will bring those who fell asleep through Jesus with him.

15 For this we say to you in a word of the Lord, that we the living, remaining unto the Lord's coming, will certainly not precede those who fell asleep,

16 because the Lord himself, with a command, with an archangel's voice and with God's trumpet, will descend from heaven, and the dead in Christ will rise first,

17 then we the living, remaining, will be caught up together with them in clouds unto a meeting with the Lord into air, and thus we will always be with the Lord.

18 So encourage one another in these words.

Chapter 5

1 And concerning the times and seasons, brothers, you have no need for writing to you,

2 for you yourselves know precisely that the Lord's day comes thus as a thief in night.

3 For when they say, “Peace and security,” then sudden destruction stands upon them, just as the birth pain upon the pregnant woman, and they will certainly not escape.

4 But you, brothers, are not in darkness, so that the day may overtake you as a thief.

5 You all are sons of light and sons of day; we are not of night nor of darkness.

6 So then let us not sleep as also the rest, but keep watch and be sober.

7 For those sleeping sleep at night, and those becoming drunk are drunk at night.

8 But we, being of day, let us be sober, putting on a breastplate of faith and love and as a helmet hope of salvation,

9 because God did not appoint us unto wrath but unto acquisition of salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ,

10 who died for us, so that whether we keep watch or sleep, we may live together with him.

11 Therefore encourage one another and build up each other, just as you also do.

12 And we ask you, brothers, to know those laboring among you and leading you in the Lord and admonishing you,

13 and consider them exceedingly in love because of their work. Be at peace among yourselves.

14 And we urge you, brothers, admonish the disorderly, console the fainthearted, hold to the weak, be patient toward all.

15 See that no one repays anyone evil for evil, but always pursue the good both toward one another and toward all.

16 Always rejoice.

17 Pray unceasingly.

18 In everything give thanks, for this is God's will in Christ Jesus toward you.

19 Do not quench the Spirit.

20 Do not despise prophecies.

21 Examine everything; hold the good.

22 Abstain from every evil form.

23 And may the God of peace himself sanctify you completely, and may your spirit and soul and body be kept whole, blamelessly at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.

24 The one calling you is faithful, who will also do it.

25 Brothers, pray concerning us.

26 Greet all the brothers with a holy kiss.

27 I adjure you by the Lord for the letter to be read to all the holy brothers.

28 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.

2 Thessalonians

Chapter 1

1 Paul and Silvanus and Timothy, to the church of Thessalonians in God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:

2 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 We ought to thank God always concerning you, brothers, just as is worthy, because your faith grows exceedingly and the love of each one of you all toward one another increases,

4 so that we ourselves boast in you in God's churches for your endurance and faith in all your persecutions and afflictions which you bear,

5 a demonstration of God's righteous judgment, for you to be counted worthy of God's kingdom, for which you also suffer,

6 if indeed it is righteous with God to repay affliction to those afflicting you,

7 and to you afflicted relief with us, at the revelation of the Lord Jesus from heaven with angels of his power,

8 in fire of flame giving vengeance to those not knowing God and those not obeying the gospel of our Lord Jesus Christ,

9 who will pay a penalty, eternal destruction away from the Lord's face and from the glory of his strength,

10 when he comes to be glorified in his saints and marveled at among all those believing, because our testimony to you was believed, on that day.

11 For which we also pray always concerning you, so that our God may count you worthy of the calling and fulfill every good pleasure of goodness and work of faith in power,

12 so that the name of our Lord Jesus Christ may be glorified in you, and you in him, according to the grace of our God and Lord Jesus Christ.

Chapter 2

1 And we ask you, brothers, concerning the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ and our gathering together to him,

2 that you not quickly be shaken from the mind nor alarmed, neither through spirit nor through word nor through a letter as through us, as though Christ's day has come.

3 Let no one deceive you in any way, because unless the apostasy comes first and the man of sin is revealed, the son of destruction,

4 who opposes and exalts himself above everything called God or an object of reverence, so that he sits in God's temple as God, displaying himself that he is God.

5 Do you not remember that while still with you I told you these things?

6 And now you know what restrains, for him to be revealed in his own time.

7 For the mystery of lawlessness already works, only the one restraining now, until he comes out of the midst.

8 And then the lawless one will be revealed, whom the Lord will consume with the breath of his mouth and nullify by the manifestation of his coming,

9 whose coming is according to Satan's working, in all power and signs and wonders of falsehood,

10 and in every deceit of unrighteousness among those perishing, because they did not accept the love of the truth for them to be saved.

11 And for this reason God will send them a working of error, for them to believe the lie,

12 so that all may be judged who did not believe the truth but were pleased in unrighteousness.

13 But we ought to thank God always concerning you, brothers beloved by the Lord, because God chose you from the beginning unto salvation in sanctification of spirit and faith of truth,

14 unto which he called you through our gospel, unto acquisition of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.

15 So then, brothers, stand and hold the traditions which you were taught, whether through word or through our letter.

16 And may our Lord Jesus Christ himself and our God and Father, who loved us and gave eternal encouragement and good hope in grace,

17 encourage your hearts and strengthen you in every good word and work.

Chapter 3

1 Finally, pray, brothers, concerning us, so that the Lord's word may run and be glorified, just as also among you,

2 and so that we may be rescued from the unreasonable and evil people, for faith is not of all.

3 But the Lord is faithful, who will strengthen you and guard you from the evil one.

4 And we trust in the Lord concerning you that what we command you, you both do and will do.

5 And may the Lord direct your hearts unto God's love and unto Christ's endurance.

6 And we command you, brothers, in our Lord Jesus Christ's name, to withdraw from every brother walking disorderly and not according to the tradition which he received from us.

7 For you yourselves know how you ought to imitate us, because we were not disorderly among you,

8 nor ate bread freely from anyone, but in labor and toil working night and day, so as not to burden any of you,

9 not that we have no authority, but so that we may give ourselves to you as a pattern, to imitate us.

10 For also when we were with you, we commanded you this, that if someone does not want to work, neither let him eat.

11 For we hear that some walk disorderly among you, working nothing but meddling.

12 And to such people we command and urge through our Lord Jesus Christ, that working with quietness they eat their own bread.

13 But you, brothers, do not lose heart doing good.

14 And if someone does not obey our word through the letter, mark this one and do not mix together with him, so that he may be shamed.

15 And do not consider him as an enemy, but admonish him as a brother.

16 And may the Lord of peace himself give you peace continually in every way. The Lord be with you all.

17 The greeting by my own hand, Paul's, which is a sign in every letter; thus I write.

18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you all. Amen.

1 Timothy

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ according to the command of God our Savior and the Lord Jesus Christ our hope,

2 to Timothy, genuine child in faith: grace, mercy, peace from God our Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

3 Just as I urged you to remain in Ephesus when traveling to Macedonia, so that you may command some not to teach differently,

4 nor attend to myths and endless genealogies, which provide inquiries rather than God's stewardship in faith.

5 But the end of the command is love from a pure heart and good conscience and unhypocritical faith,

6 from which some, missing the mark, turned aside to futile speech,

7 wanting to be teachers of law, understanding neither what they say nor concerning what they affirm.

8 But we know that the law is good, if someone uses it lawfully,

9 knowing this, that law is not laid down for a righteous one, but for lawless and unsubmissive ones, ungodly and sinners, unholy and profane, father-strikers and mother-strikers, man-killers,

10 sexually immoral people, men who bed males, enslavers of people, liars, perjurers, and if anything else opposes the healthy teaching,

11 according to the gospel of the glory of the blessed God, with which I was entrusted.

12 And I have thanks to Christ Jesus our Lord who empowered me, because he considered me faithful, appointing me to ministry,

13 formerly being a blasphemer and persecutor and insolent one; but I received mercy because, not knowing, I did it in unbelief.

14 And our Lord's grace increased exceedingly with faith and love in Christ Jesus.

15 The word is faithful and worthy of all acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am first.

16 But for this reason I received mercy, so that in me first Jesus Christ may demonstrate all patience, for a pattern of those about to believe upon him unto eternal life.

17 And to the King of the ages, incorruptible, invisible, only wise God, honor and glory unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

18 This command I entrust to you, child Timothy, according to the prophecies going before concerning you, so that in them you may wage the good warfare,

19 having faith and a good conscience, which some, rejecting, were shipwrecked concerning faith,

20 of whom are Hymenaeus and Alexander, whom I handed over to Satan so that they may be disciplined not to blaspheme.

Chapter 2

1 Therefore I urge first of all that petitions, prayers, intercessions, thanksgivings be made for all people,

2 for kings and all those in high position, so that we may lead a tranquil and quiet life in all piety and dignity.

3 For this is good and acceptable before God our Savior,

4 who wants all people to be saved and come unto knowledge of truth.

5 For one God, also one mediator of God and people, a man, Christ Jesus,

6 who gave himself as a corresponding ransom for all, the testimony in its own times,

7 for which I was appointed a herald and apostle—I speak truth in Christ, do not lie—a teacher of nations in faith and truth.

8 Therefore I want the men to pray in every place, lifting holy hands without wrath and reasoning,

9 likewise also the women to adorn themselves in orderly attire with modesty and sound-mindedness, not in braids or gold or pearls or costly clothing,

10 but what is fitting for women professing reverence for God, through good works.

11 Let a woman learn in quietness in all submission.

12 But I do not permit a woman to teach nor to exercise authority over a man, but to be in quietness.

13 For Adam was formed first, then Eve,

14 and Adam was not deceived, but the woman, deceived, has come into transgression.

15 But she will be saved through childbearing, if they remain in faith and love and sanctification with sound-mindedness.

Chapter 3

1 The word is faithful: if someone aspires to oversight, he desires a good work.

2 Therefore the overseer must be irreproachable, husband of one wife, sober, sound-minded, orderly, hospitable, able to teach,

3 not given to wine, not a striker, not greedy for shameful gain, but fair, not quarrelsome, not loving silver,

4 leading his own household well, having children in submission with all dignity,

5 but if someone does not know to lead his own household, how will he care for God's church?

6 Not newly planted, so that being puffed up he may not fall into the devil's judgment.

7 And he must also have a good testimony from those outside, so that he may not fall into reproach and the devil's snare.

8 Ministers likewise dignified, not double-speaking, not attending to much wine, not greedy for shameful gain,

9 having the mystery of faith in a pure conscience.

10 And let these too be examined first, then minister, being unaccused.

11 Women likewise dignified, not slanderers, sober, faithful in everything.

12 Let ministers be husbands of one wife, leading children and their own households well.

13 For those who ministered well acquire for themselves a good standing and much boldness in faith in Christ Jesus.

14 I write these things to you, hoping to come to you sooner,

15 but if I delay, so that you may know how one ought to conduct oneself in God's household, which is the church of the living God, a pillar and support of the truth.

16 And confessedly great is the mystery of piety: God was manifested in flesh, justified in spirit, seen by angels, preached among nations, believed in a world, taken up in glory.

Chapter 4

1 And the Spirit expressly says that in later times some will depart from the faith, attending to deceiving spirits and teachings of demons,

2 in hypocrisy of lie-speakers seared in their own conscience,

3 forbidding to marry, to abstain from foods which God created for partaking with thanksgiving by the faithful and those who fully know the truth.

4 Because every creation of God is good, and nothing to be rejected when received with thanksgiving,

5 for it is sanctified through God's word and intercession.

6 Setting these things before the brothers, you will be a good minister of Jesus Christ, nourished in the words of faith and the good teaching which you have followed.

7 But refuse profane and old-womanish myths, and train yourself toward piety.

8 For bodily training is beneficial for a little, but piety is beneficial for everything, having promise of the present life and the coming one.

9 The word is faithful and worthy of all acceptance.

10 For unto this we also labor and are reproached, because we have hoped upon the living God, who is Savior of all people, especially believers.

11 Command these things and teach.

12 Let no one despise your youth, but become a pattern of the believers in word, in conduct, in love, in spirit, in faith, in purity.

13 Until I come, attend to reading, to exhortation, to teaching.

14 Do not neglect the gracious gift within you, which was given to you through prophecy with the laying on of the hands of the eldership.

15 Practice these things, be in these things, so that your advancement may be manifest among all.

16 Attend to yourself and the teaching; remain in them, for doing this you will save both yourself and those hearing you.

Chapter 5

1 Do not rebuke an older man harshly, but urge him as a father, younger men as brothers,

2 older women as mothers, younger women as sisters, in all purity.

3 Honor widows who are truly widows.

4 But if some widow has children or descendants, let them learn first to show piety toward their own household and repay recompenses to the ancestors, for this is good and acceptable before God.

5 But the one truly a widow and left alone has hoped upon God and remains in petitions and prayers night and day,

6 but the one living luxuriously has died while living.

7 And command these things, so that they may be irreproachable.

8 But if someone does not take forethought for his own, and especially the household, he has denied the faith and is worse than an unbeliever.

9 Let a widow be enrolled who has become not less than sixty years old, wife of one husband,

10 attested in good works, if she raised children, if she received strangers, if she washed saints' feet, if she aided the afflicted, if she followed every good work.

11 But refuse younger widows, for when they grow wanton against Christ, they want to marry,

12 having judgment because they rejected the first faith.

13 And at the same time they also learn to be idle, going around the houses, and not only idle but also gossips and meddlers, speaking things they ought not.

14 Therefore I want younger women to marry, bear children, rule the household, give no opportunity to the opponent for reviling,

15 for already some turned aside after Satan.

16 If some believing man or believing woman has widows, let them aid them, and let the church not be burdened, so that it may aid those truly widows.

17 Let the elders who have led well be counted worthy of double honor, especially those laboring in word and teaching.

18 For the Scripture says, “You shall not muzzle a threshing ox,” and “The worker is worthy of his wage.”

19 Do not accept an accusation against an elder except upon two or three witnesses.

20 Expose those sinning before all, so that the rest too may have fear.

21 I solemnly testify before God and the Lord Jesus Christ and the chosen angels, that you keep these things without prejudgment, doing nothing according to partiality.

22 Lay hands quickly upon no one, nor share in others' sins; keep yourself pure.

23 No longer drink water only, but use a little wine because of your stomach and your frequent weaknesses.

24 Some people's sins are evident beforehand, going before unto judgment, but for some they also follow after.

25 Likewise also the good works are evident beforehand, and those otherwise cannot be hidden.

Chapter 6

1 As many as are slaves under a yoke, let them consider their own masters worthy of all honor, so that God's name and the teaching may not be blasphemed.

2 And those having believing masters, let them not despise them because they are brothers, but rather serve as slaves, because those receiving the benefit are faithful and beloved. Teach these things and exhort.

3 If someone teaches differently and does not approach healthy words, those of our Lord Jesus Christ, and the teaching according to piety,

4 he has been puffed up, knowing nothing, but diseased concerning inquiries and word-fights, from which come envy, strife, slanders, evil suspicions,

5 constant frictions of people corrupted in mind and deprived of the truth, considering piety to be gain. Depart from such people.

6 But piety with sufficiency is great gain.

7 For we brought nothing into the world; it is clear that neither can we carry anything out.

8 But having nourishment and coverings, with these we will be content.

9 But those wanting to be rich fall into temptation and a snare and many senseless and harmful desires, which plunge people into ruin and destruction.

10 For the love of silver is a root of all evils, which some, aspiring to, wandered from the faith and pierced themselves through with many pains.

11 But you, O man of God, flee these things, and pursue righteousness, piety, faith, love, endurance, gentleness.

12 Struggle the good struggle of faith; grasp eternal life, unto which you were also called and confessed the good confession before many witnesses.

13 I command you before God who gives life to all things and Christ Jesus who testified the good confession before Pontius Pilate,

14 that you keep the commandment spotless, irreproachable, until the manifestation of our Lord Jesus Christ,

15 which in its own times the blessed and only Sovereign will show, the King of those reigning and Lord of those ruling,

16 who alone has immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light, whom none of people saw nor can see, to whom honor and eternal might. Amen.

17 Command the rich in the present age not to be high-minded nor to hope upon uncertainty of riches, but in the living God who provides us everything richly for enjoyment,

18 to work good, to be rich in good works, to be ready to share, generous,

19 storing up for themselves a good foundation for the future, so that they may grasp eternal life.

20 O Timothy, guard the deposit, turning aside from profane empty sounds and oppositions of falsely named knowledge,

21 which some professing missed the mark concerning faith. Grace be with you. Amen.

2 Timothy

Chapter 1

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ through God's will, according to promise of life in Christ Jesus,

2 to Timothy, beloved child: grace, mercy, peace from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.

3 I have thanks to God, whom I serve from ancestors in a pure conscience, as I have unceasing remembrance concerning you in my petitions night and day,

4 longing to see you, remembering your tears, so that I may be filled with joy,

5 receiving remembrance of the unhypocritical faith in you, which dwelt first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice, and I am convinced also in you.

6 For which reason I remind you to rekindle God's gracious gift, which is in you through the laying on of my hands.

7 For God did not give us a spirit of cowardice, but of power and love and sound-minded discipline.

8 Therefore do not be ashamed of our Lord's testimony nor of me his prisoner, but suffer hardship together for the gospel according to God's power,

9 who saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works but according to his own purpose and grace given to us in Christ Jesus before eternal times,

10 but manifested now through the manifestation of our Savior Jesus Christ, who nullified death and illuminated life and incorruptibility through the gospel,

11 for which I was appointed a herald and apostle and teacher of nations.

12 For which reason I also suffer these things, but I am not ashamed, for I know whom I have believed, and am convinced that he is able to guard my deposit unto that day.

13 Have a pattern of healthy words which you heard from me, in faith and love in Christ Jesus.

14 Guard the good deposit through the Holy Spirit dwelling in us.

15 You know this, that all those in Asia turned away from me, of whom are Phygellus and Hermogenes.

16 May the Lord give mercy to Onesiphorus's household, because he often refreshed me and was not ashamed of my chain,

17 but being in Rome, sought me more diligently and found me.

18 May the Lord give him to find mercy from the Lord on that day; and how much he ministered in Ephesus, you know better.

Chapter 2

1 Therefore you, my child, be empowered in the grace in Christ Jesus,

2 and what you heard from me through many witnesses, entrust these things to faithful people who will be fit also to teach others.

3 Therefore you suffer hardship as a good soldier of Jesus Christ.

4 No one serving as a soldier entangles himself in life's affairs, so that he may please the one who enlisted him.

5 And if someone also competes, he is not crowned unless he competes lawfully.

6 The laboring farmer must first partake of the fruits.

7 Understand what I say, for may the Lord give you understanding in everything.

8 Remember Jesus Christ, raised from the dead, from David's seed, according to my gospel,

9 in which I suffer hardship until bonds as a criminal, but God's word has not been bound.

10 For this reason I endure everything because of the chosen ones, so that they too may obtain salvation in Christ Jesus with eternal glory.

11 The word is faithful: for if we died together, we will also live together;

12 if we endure, we will also reign together; if we deny, he too will deny us;

13 if we are unfaithful, he remains faithful; he cannot deny himself.

14 Remind them of these things, solemnly testifying before the Lord not to fight over words, useful for nothing, unto overthrow of those hearing.

15 Be diligent to present yourself approved to God, a worker without shame, cutting straight the word of truth.

16 But avoid profane empty sounds, for they will advance unto more ungodliness,

17 and their word will have spread as gangrene, of whom are Hymenaeus and Philetus,

18 who missed the mark concerning truth, saying that the resurrection has already happened, and overturn some people's faith.

19 Nevertheless God's firm foundation stands, having this seal: “The Lord knew those who are his,” and “Let everyone naming Christ's name depart from unrighteousness.”

20 And in a great house there are not only gold and silver vessels, but also wooden and earthen, and some for honor, some for dishonor.

21 Therefore if someone cleanses himself from these, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified and useful to the master, prepared for every good work.

22 And flee youthful desires, but pursue righteousness, faith, love, peace with those calling upon the Lord from a pure heart.

23 But refuse foolish and uninstructed inquiries, knowing that they bear fights.

24 And the Lord's slave must not fight, but be gentle toward all, able to teach, patient under evil,

25 in gentleness disciplining those opposing, lest perhaps God give them repentance unto knowledge of truth,

26 and they become sober again out of the devil's snare, having been captured alive by him unto his will.

Chapter 3

1 And know this, that in last days difficult times will come.

2 For people will be self-lovers, silver-lovers, boastful, arrogant, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy,

3 without natural affection, implacable, slanderers, without self-control, untamed, not loving good,

4 traitors, reckless, puffed up, pleasure-lovers rather than God-lovers,

5 having a form of piety but having denied its power; and turn away from these.

6 For from these are those entering the houses and taking captive the little women heaped with sins, led by various desires,

7 always learning and never able to come unto knowledge of truth.

8 And in the way Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses, so these too oppose the truth, people corrupted in mind, disapproved concerning faith.

9 But they will not advance further, for their senselessness will be evident to all, as that of those also became.

10 But you have followed my teaching, conduct, purpose, faith, patience, love, endurance,

11 persecutions, sufferings, such as happened to me in Antioch, in Iconium, in Lystra, what sort of persecutions I endured; and from all the Lord rescued me.

12 And also all those wanting to live piously in Christ Jesus will be persecuted.

13 But evil people and impostors will advance toward the worse, deceiving and being deceived.

14 But you remain in what you learned and were assured of, knowing from whom you learned,

15 and that from infancy you know the sacred letters, able to make you wise unto salvation through faith in Christ Jesus.

16 Every writing is God-breathed and beneficial for teaching, for conviction, for correction, for discipline in righteousness,

17 so that God's man may be complete, equipped for every good work.

Chapter 4

1 Therefore I solemnly testify before God and the Lord Jesus Christ, who is about to judge living and dead according to his manifestation and his kingdom:

2 preach the word, stand ready opportunely, inopportunely, convict, rebuke, exhort in all patience and teaching.

3 For a time will be when they will not bear the healthy teaching, but according to their own desires will heap up teachers for themselves, itching in hearing,

4 and will turn their hearing away from the truth, but turn aside to the myths.

5 But you be sober in everything, suffer hardship, do an evangelist's work, fulfill your ministry.

6 For I am already being poured out, and the time of my departure has come.

7 I have struggled the good struggle, completed the race, kept the faith.

8 Henceforth the crown of righteousness is laid away for me, which the Lord, the righteous judge, will repay me on that day, and not to me only but also to all who have loved his manifestation.

9 Be diligent to come to me quickly,

10 for Demas abandoned me, loving the present age, and traveled to Thessalonica, Crescens to Galatia, Titus to Dalmatia.

11 Luke alone is with me. Taking Mark, bring him with yourself, for he is useful to me for ministry.

12 And I sent Tychicus to Ephesus.

13 When coming, bring the cloak which I left in Troas with Carpus, and the books, especially the parchments.

14 Alexander the coppersmith demonstrated many evil things to me; may the Lord repay him according to his works.

15 You too guard against him, for he greatly opposed our words.

16 At my first defense no one stood with me, but all abandoned me; may it not be reckoned to them.

17 But the Lord stood by me and empowered me, so that through me the proclamation may be fulfilled and all the nations hear; and I was rescued from a lion's mouth.

18 And the Lord will rescue me from every evil work and save me unto his heavenly kingdom, to whom the glory unto the ages of the ages. Amen.

19 Greet Prisca and Aquila and Onesiphorus's household.

20 Erastus remained in Corinth, but I left Trophimus in Miletus sick.

21 Be diligent to come before winter. Eubulus greets you, and Pudens and Linus and Claudia and all the brothers.

22 The Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Grace be with you. Amen.

Titus

Chapter 1

1 Paul, God's slave and an apostle of Jesus Christ, according to faith of God's chosen ones and knowledge of truth according to piety,

2 upon hope of eternal life, which God who does not lie promised before eternal times,

3 but manifested his word in its own times in proclamation, with which I was entrusted according to the command of God our Savior,

4 to Titus, genuine child according to common faith: grace, mercy, peace from God the Father and the Lord Jesus Christ our Savior.

5 For this reason I left you in Crete, so that you may set right the things lacking and appoint elders city by city, as I directed you,

6 if someone is unaccused, husband of one wife, having faithful children, not in accusation of dissipation or unsubmissive.

7 For the overseer must be unaccused as God's steward, not self-willed, not prone to anger, not given to wine, not a striker, not greedy for shameful gain,

8 but hospitable, loving good, sound-minded, righteous, holy, self-controlled,

9 holding to the faithful word according to the teaching, so that he may be able both to exhort in the healthy teaching and convict those contradicting.

10 For there are also many unsubmissive people, futile speakers and mind-deceivers, especially those of circumcision,

11 whose mouths must be stopped, who overturn whole households, teaching what they ought not, for shameful gain.

12 Someone from them, their own prophet, said, “Cretans always liars, evil beasts, idle bellies.”

13 This testimony is true; for which reason convict them severely, so that they may be healthy in faith,

14 not attending to Jewish myths and commandments of people turning away from the truth.

15 All things indeed are clean to the clean, but to the defiled and unbelieving nothing is clean, but both their mind and conscience have been defiled.

16 They confess to know God, but deny him in works, being abominable and disobedient and disapproved for every good work.

Chapter 2

1 But you speak what is fitting for the healthy teaching,

2 for older men to be sober, dignified, sound-minded, healthy in faith, in love, in endurance;

3 older women likewise reverent in demeanor, not slanderers, not enslaved to much wine, teachers of good,

4 so that they may train the young women to be husband-lovers, child-lovers,

5 sound-minded, pure, keepers at home, good, submitting to their own husbands, so that God's word may not be blasphemed.

6 Likewise urge the younger men to be sound-minded,

7 in everything providing yourself as a pattern of good works, in the teaching incorruption, dignity, incorruptibility,

8 a healthy word not condemnable, so that the one on the opposing side may be shamed, having nothing bad to say concerning you.

9 Slaves to submit to their own masters, to be pleasing in everything, not contradicting,

10 not pilfering, but demonstrating all good faithfulness, so that they may adorn the teaching of God your Savior in everything.

11 For God's grace appeared, saving for all people,

12 disciplining us, so that denying ungodliness and worldly desires, we may live sound-mindedly and righteously and piously in the present age,

13 awaiting the blessed hope and manifestation of the glory of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ,

14 who gave himself for us, so that he may redeem us from all lawlessness and cleanse for himself a special people, zealous for good works.

15 Speak these things and exhort and convict with all command. Let no one despise you.

Chapter 3

1 Remind them to submit to rulers and authorities, to obey, to be ready for every good work,

2 to slander no one, to be unquarrelsome, fair, demonstrating all gentleness toward all people.

3 For we too once were senseless, disobedient, deceived, serving as slaves to various desires and pleasures, living in malice and envy, hateful, hating one another.

4 But when the kindness and love for humanity of God our Savior appeared,

5 not from works in righteousness which we did, but according to his mercy he saved us, through washing of rebirth and renewal of the Holy Spirit,

6 whom he poured out upon us richly through Jesus Christ our Savior,

7 so that justified by his grace we may become heirs according to hope of eternal life.

8 The word is faithful, and concerning these things I want you to affirm, so that those who have believed God may care to lead in good works. These things are good and beneficial for people.

9 But avoid foolish inquiries and genealogies and strifes and legal fights, for they are unbeneficial and futile.

10 Refuse a heretical man after a first and second admonition,

11 knowing that such a one has been perverted and sins, being self-condemned.

12 When I send Artemas to you or Tychicus, be diligent to come to me in Nicopolis, for there I have decided to winter.

13 Send onward Zenas the lawyer and Apollos diligently, so that nothing may lack to them.

14 And let our people too learn to lead in good works for necessary needs, so that they may not be fruitless.

15 All those with me greet you. Greet those loving us in faith. Grace be with you all. Amen.

Philemon

Chapter 1

1 Paul, Christ Jesus's prisoner, and Timothy the brother, to Philemon our beloved and fellow worker,

2 and Apphia the beloved and Archippus our fellow soldier and the church in your house:

3 grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

4 I thank my God always, making mention of you in my prayers,

5 hearing your love and faith which you have toward the Lord Jesus and toward all the saints,

6 so that the fellowship of your faith may become effective in knowledge of every good thing in you unto Christ Jesus.

7 For we have much thanks and encouragement for your love, because the inward affections of the saints have been refreshed through you, brother.

8 Therefore, having much boldness in Christ to command you what is fitting,

9 because of love I rather urge, being such a one as Paul, an old man, and now also Jesus Christ's prisoner.

10 I urge you concerning my child whom I begot in my bonds, Onesimus,

11 formerly useless to you, but now useful to you and me,

12 whom I sent back; but you receive him, that is, my inward affections,

13 whom I wanted to keep with myself, so that for you he may minister to me in the bonds of the gospel.

14 But without your judgment I wanted to do nothing, so that your good may not be as according to necessity but according to willingness.

15 For perhaps for this reason he was separated for an hour, so that you may have him eternally,

16 no longer as a slave but beyond a slave, a beloved brother, especially to me, but how much more to you, both in flesh and in the Lord.

17 Therefore if you hold me as a partner, receive him as me.

18 But if he wronged you anything or owes, charge this to me.

19 I, Paul, wrote with my own hand, I will repay, so that I may not tell you that you also owe yourself to me besides.

20 Yes, brother, may I benefit from you in the Lord; refresh my inward affections in the Lord.

21 Trusting your obedience, I wrote to you, knowing that you will also do beyond what I say.

22 And at the same time also prepare lodging for me, for I hope that through your prayers I will be freely given to you.

23 Epaphras my fellow captive in Christ Jesus greets you,

24 Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, Luke, my fellow workers.

25 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with your spirit. Amen.

Hebrews

Chapter 1

1 In many portions and many ways, God, having spoken long ago to the fathers in the prophets,

2 at the last of these days spoke to us in a Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, through whom he also made the ages,

3 who, being radiance of the glory and imprint of his substance, and carrying all things by the word of his power, having made purification of our sins through himself, sat at the right hand of the Majesty in high places,

4 becoming so much better than the angels as he has inherited a name more excellent than theirs.

5 For to which of the angels did he ever say, “You are my Son, I today have begotten you,” and again, “I will be a Father to him, and he will be a Son to me”?

6 And when he again brings the firstborn into the inhabited world, he says, “And let all God's angels worship him.”

7 And concerning the angels he says, “The one making his angels spirits and his servants a flame of fire,”

8 but concerning the Son, “Your throne, O God, is unto the age of the age; a rod of uprightness is the rod of your kingdom.

9 You loved righteousness and hated lawlessness; for this reason God, your God, anointed you with oil of exultation beyond your partners.”

10 And, “You, at the beginnings, Lord, founded the earth, and the heavens are works of your hands.

11 They will perish, but you remain, and all will grow old as a garment,

12 and as a covering you will roll them up, and they will be changed; but you are the same, and your years will not fail.”

13 But to which of the angels has he ever said, “Sit at my right hand until I place your enemies as a footstool of your feet”?

14 Are they not all serving spirits, sent out for ministry because of those about to inherit salvation?

Chapter 2

1 For this reason we must attend more abundantly to the things heard, lest we drift away.

2 For if the word spoken through angels became firm, and every transgression and disobedience received a just recompense,

3 how will we escape, neglecting so great a salvation, which, beginning to be spoken through the Lord, was confirmed to us by those who heard,

4 God bearing witness together with signs and wonders and various powers and distributions of the Holy Spirit according to his own will?

5 For not to angels did he subject the coming inhabited world, concerning which we speak.

6 But someone somewhere solemnly testified, saying, “What is man, that you remember him, or a son of man, that you visit him?

7 You made him a little lower than angels; you crowned him with glory and honor and appointed him over the works of your hands;

8 you subjected all things beneath his feet.” For in subjecting all things to him, he left nothing unsubmissive to him; but now we do not yet see all things subjected to him.

9 But we see Jesus, made a little lower than angels, crowned with glory and honor because of the suffering of death, so that by God's grace he may taste death for everyone.

10 For it was fitting for him, because of whom are all things and through whom are all things, bringing many sons into glory, to perfect the founder of their salvation through sufferings.

11 For both the one sanctifying and those being sanctified are all from one, for which reason he is not ashamed to call them brothers,

12 saying, “I will announce your name to my brothers; in the midst of an assembly I will hymn you.”

13 And again, “I will be trusting upon him,” and again, “Look, I and the children whom God gave me.”

14 Therefore, since the children have shared flesh and blood, he himself also similarly partook of the same, so that through death he may nullify the one having the might of death, that is, the devil,

15 and release those who through fear of death were liable to slavery throughout all their living.

16 For surely he does not take hold of angels, but takes hold of Abraham's seed.

17 Therefore he ought to be made like the brothers in everything, so that he may become a merciful and faithful high priest in the things toward God, to make propitiation for the people's sins.

18 For in that he himself has suffered, being tempted, he is able to help those being tempted.

Chapter 3

1 Therefore, holy brothers, partners of a heavenly calling, consider the apostle and high priest of our confession, Christ Jesus,

2 being faithful to the one who made him, as also Moses in all his house.

3 For this one has been counted worthy of more glory than Moses, insofar as the one who constructed the house has more honor than it.

4 For every house is constructed by someone, but the one who constructed all things is God.

5 And Moses indeed faithful in all his house as an attendant, for a testimony of the things to be spoken,

6 but Christ as a Son over his house, whose house we are, if indeed we hold firm the boldness and boast of hope until the end.

7 Therefore, just as the Holy Spirit says, “Today, if you hear his voice,

8 do not harden your hearts as in the provocation, on the day of temptation in the wilderness,

9 where your fathers tempted me, tested me, and saw my works forty years.

10 Therefore I was indignant with that generation and said, ‘They always err in heart, and they did not know my ways.’

11 As I swore in my wrath, ‘They shall not enter my rest.’”

12 Watch, brothers, lest there be in someone of you an evil heart of unbelief in departing from the living God,

13 but encourage one another each day, as long as it is called Today, so that no one of you may be hardened by sin's deceit.

14 For we have become partners of Christ, if indeed we hold firm the beginning of the confidence until the end,

15 in its being said, “Today, if you hear his voice, do not harden your hearts as in the provocation.”

16 For who, having heard, provoked? But was it not all those who came out from Egypt through Moses?

17 And with whom was he indignant forty years? Was it not those who sinned, whose limbs fell in the wilderness?

18 And to whom did he swear that they would not enter his rest, except those who disobeyed?

19 And we see that they could not enter because of unbelief.

Chapter 4

1 Therefore let us fear lest, a promise of entering his rest being left, someone of you may seem to have fallen short.

2 For we too have had good news proclaimed, just as those also; but the word of hearing did not benefit those, not having been mixed with faith for those who heard.

3 For we who believed enter the rest, just as he has said, “As I swore in my wrath, ‘They shall not enter my rest,’” although the works had come to be from a world's foundation.

4 For he has said somewhere concerning the seventh thus, “And God rested on the seventh day from all his works,”

5 and in this again, “They shall not enter my rest.”

6 Therefore, since it remains for some to enter it, and those formerly receiving good news did not enter because of disobedience,

7 again he designates some day, Today, saying in David after so much time, just as it has been said, “Today, if you hear his voice, do not harden your hearts.”

8 For if Joshua gave them rest, he would not speak after these things concerning another day.

9 Therefore a sabbath rest remains for God's people.

10 For the one entering his rest also himself rested from his works, just as God from his own.

11 Therefore let us be diligent to enter that rest, so that no one may fall in the same example of disobedience.

12 For God's word is living and effective and sharper than every two-edged sword, and penetrating until division of both soul and spirit, both joints and marrows, and judging thoughts and intentions of heart.

13 And there is no creation invisible before him, but all things naked and laid bare to his eyes, to whom our account is.

14 Therefore, having a great high priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus God's Son, let us hold the confession.

15 For we do not have a high priest unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but one tempted in everything according to likeness, without sin.

16 Therefore let us approach the throne of grace with boldness, so that we may receive mercy and find grace for timely help.

Chapter 5

1 For every high priest, taken from among men, is appointed on behalf of men in the things pertaining to God, so that he may offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins,

2 being able to deal moderately with those who are ignorant and wandering, since he himself is also surrounded by weakness.

3 And because of this he is obliged, just as for the people, so also for himself, to offer for sins.

4 And no one takes the honor for himself, but the one called by God, just as Aaron also was.

5 So also Christ did not glorify himself to become high priest, but the one who spoke to him: You are my Son; today I have begotten you.

6 As he also says in another place: You are a priest forever according to the order of Melchizedek.

7 Who, in the days of his flesh, having offered both petitions and supplications to the one able to save him out of death, with a strong cry and tears, and having been heard because of his reverence,

8 although being a Son, learned obedience from the things he suffered.

9 And having been perfected, he became the cause of eternal salvation to all those obeying him,

10 being designated by God high priest according to the order of Melchizedek.

11 Concerning whom we have much to say, and difficult to explain in speaking, since you have become sluggish in hearing.

12 For although you ought to be teachers because of the time, you again have need of someone to teach you the elements of the beginning of the oracles of God, and you have come to have need of milk and not solid food.

13 For everyone partaking of milk is inexperienced in the word of righteousness, for he is an infant.

14 But solid food belongs to the mature, those who through practice have their senses trained for distinguishing both good and evil.

Chapter 6

1 Therefore, leaving the word of the beginning of Christ, let us be carried on to perfection, not laying down again a foundation of repentance from dead works and faith toward God,

2 of instruction concerning washings, and laying on of hands, and resurrection of the dead, and eternal judgment.

3 And this we will do, if indeed God permits.

4 For it is impossible for those once enlightened, who have tasted the heavenly gift and become partakers of the Holy Spirit,

5 and tasted the good word of God and powers of the coming age,

6 and fallen away, to renew them again to repentance, crucifying again for themselves the Son of God and exposing him publicly.

7 For land that has drunk the rain often coming upon it, and produces vegetation useful to those for whom it is also cultivated, partakes of blessing from God.

8 But producing thorns and thistles, it is rejected and near a curse, whose end is for burning.

9 But we are persuaded concerning you, beloved, of better things and things belonging to salvation, even if we speak thus.

10 For God is not unjust to forget your work and the labor of love which you displayed toward his name, having served the saints and serving them.

11 But we desire each of you to display the same diligence toward the full assurance of hope until the end,

12 so that you may not become sluggish, but imitators of those inheriting the promises through faith and patience.

13 For God, having made a promise to Abraham, since he had no one greater by whom to swear, swore by himself,

14 saying: Surely, blessing I will bless you, and multiplying I will multiply you.

15 And thus, having been patient, he obtained the promise.

16 For men indeed swear by the greater, and the oath for confirmation is an end to all dispute for them.

17 In which God, wishing more abundantly to show the heirs of the promise the unchangeableness of his purpose, intervened with an oath,

18 so that through two unchangeable things, in which it is impossible for God to lie, we who have fled for refuge might have strong encouragement to take hold of the hope set before us,

19 which we have as an anchor of the soul, both secure and firm, and entering into the interior of the curtain,

20 where Jesus entered as a forerunner on our behalf, having become high priest forever according to the order of Melchizedek.

Chapter 7

1 For this Melchizedek, king of Salem, priest of God Most High, who met Abraham returning from the slaughter of the kings and blessed him,

2 to whom Abraham also apportioned a tenth from everything, is first, by interpretation, king of righteousness, and then also king of Salem, which is king of peace,

3 without father, without mother, without genealogy, having neither beginning of days nor end of life, but having been made like the Son of God, remains a priest continually.

4 But consider how great this man was, to whom even Abraham the patriarch gave a tenth from the spoils.

5 And indeed those from the sons of Levi receiving the priesthood have a commandment to take tithes from the people according to the law, that is, their brothers, although they have come out of the loins of Abraham.

6 But the one not tracing his genealogy from them has taken tithes from Abraham and has blessed the one having the promises.

7 But without any dispute the lesser is blessed by the better.

8 And here indeed dying men receive tithes, but there one who is testified to that he lives.

9 And, so to speak, through Abraham even Levi, who receives tithes, has been tithed.

10 For he was still in the loins of his father when Melchizedek met him.

11 If therefore perfection was through the Levitical priesthood, for the people had received the law on its basis, what further need was there for another priest to arise according to the order of Melchizedek and not to be called according to the order of Aaron?

12 For when the priesthood is changed, of necessity a change of law also takes place.

13 For the one of whom these things are said has partaken of another tribe, from which no one has attended to the altar.

14 For it is evident that our Lord has sprung from Judah, concerning which tribe Moses spoke nothing about priesthood.

15 And it is still more abundantly evident if another priest arises according to the likeness of Melchizedek,

16 who has become such, not according to a law of a fleshly commandment, but according to the power of an indestructible life.

17 For he testifies: You are a priest forever according to the order of Melchizedek.

18 For indeed a setting aside of the preceding commandment takes place because of its weakness and uselessness,

19 for the law perfected nothing, but there is a bringing in of a better hope, through which we draw near to God.

20 And insofar as it was not without an oath,

21 for they indeed have become priests without an oath, but he with an oath through the one saying to him: The Lord swore and will not change his mind: You are a priest forever according to the order of Melchizedek,

22 by so much Jesus has become guarantor of a better covenant.

23 And they indeed have become many priests because they are prevented by death from remaining.

24 But he, because he remains forever, has the priesthood that does not pass to another.

25 Therefore he is also able to save completely those approaching God through him, always living to intercede on their behalf.

26 For such a high priest was fitting for us, holy, innocent, undefiled, separated from sinners, and having become higher than the heavens,

27 who does not have a daily necessity, like the high priests, first to offer sacrifices for his own sins, then for those of the people; for this he did once for all, having offered himself.

28 For the law appoints men as high priests who have weakness, but the word of the oath, which came after the law, appoints a Son perfected forever.

Chapter 8

1 Now the main point in the things being said: we have such a high priest, who sat down at the right hand of the throne of the Majesty in the heavens,

2 a minister of the holy places and of the true tent, which the Lord erected, and not man.

3 For every high priest is appointed to offer both gifts and sacrifices; therefore it is necessary for this one also to have something which he may offer.

4 For if he were on earth, he would not even be a priest, since there are priests offering the gifts according to the law,

5 who serve a copy and shadow of the heavenly things, just as Moses was instructed when about to complete the tent; for he says: See that you make everything according to the pattern shown to you on the mountain.

6 But now he has obtained a more excellent ministry, by as much as he is also mediator of a better covenant, which has been established as law upon better promises.

7 For if that first one were faultless, a place would not have been sought for a second.

8 For finding fault with them, he says: Behold, days are coming, says the Lord, and I will conclude a new covenant with the house of Israel and with the house of Judah,

9 not according to the covenant which I made with their fathers on the day when I took hold of their hand to lead them out of the land of Egypt, because they did not remain in my covenant, and I disregarded them, says the Lord.

10 For this is the covenant which I will make with the house of Israel after those days, says the Lord: Putting my laws into their understanding, I will also inscribe them upon their hearts, and I will be God to them, and they will be a people to me.

11 And they will certainly not teach, each his neighbor and each his brother, saying: Know the Lord; because all will know me, from their small to their great.

12 Because I will be merciful to their unrighteousness, and their sins and their lawless deeds I will certainly remember no more.

13 In saying: New, he has made the first old. But what is becoming old and aging is near disappearance.

Chapter 9

1 Therefore the first tent also indeed had ordinances of worship and the earthly sanctuary.

2 For a tent was prepared, the first, in which were both the lampstand and the table and the presentation of the loaves, which is called the Holy Place.

3 But after the second curtain was a tent called the Holy of Holies,

4 having a golden censer and the ark of the covenant covered on all sides with gold, in which were a golden jar containing the manna, and Aaron's rod that sprouted, and the tablets of the covenant.

5 And above it were cherubim of glory overshadowing the place of atonement, concerning which it is not now possible to speak in detail.

6 Now these things having been thus prepared, the priests continually enter into the first tent, performing the services of worship.

7 But into the second, the high priest alone once a year, not without blood, which he offers for himself and the ignorant offenses of the people,

8 the Holy Spirit indicating this: that the way of the holy places has not yet been manifested while the first tent still has standing,

9 which is a parable for the present time, according to which both gifts and sacrifices are offered that cannot perfect the worshiper with respect to conscience,

10 being imposed only in foods and drinks and various washings and ordinances of flesh until a time of rectification.

11 But Christ, having come as high priest of the coming good things, through the greater and more perfect tent, not made by hands, that is, not of this creation,

12 nor through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered once for all into the holy places, having obtained eternal redemption.

13 For if the blood of bulls and goats, and ashes of a heifer sprinkling those who have been defiled, sanctify for the cleanness of the flesh,

14 how much more will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without blemish to God, cleanse your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?

15 And because of this he is mediator of a new covenant, so that, a death having taken place for redemption of the transgressions under the first covenant, those called may receive the promise of the eternal inheritance.

16 For where there is a testament, it is necessary that the death of the one who made it be brought forward.

17 For a testament is firm upon the dead, since it never has force while the one who made it lives.

18 Therefore not even the first has been inaugurated without blood.

19 For when every commandment according to the law had been spoken by Moses to all the people, taking the blood of the calves and goats with water and scarlet wool and hyssop, he sprinkled both the book itself and all the people,

20 saying: This is the blood of the covenant which God commanded for you.

21 And he likewise sprinkled with the blood both the tent and all the vessels of the ministry.

22 And almost everything is cleansed with blood according to the law, and without shedding of blood forgiveness does not take place.

23 Therefore it was necessary for the copies of the things in the heavens to be cleansed with these, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.

24 For Christ did not enter holy places made by hands, counterparts of the true ones, but into heaven itself, now to appear before the face of God on our behalf,

25 nor so that he might offer himself often, as the high priest enters into the holy places year by year with another's blood.

26 Since then he would have had to suffer often from the foundation of the world; but now once, at the consummation of the ages, he has been manifested for the setting aside of sin through his sacrifice.

27 And just as it is appointed for men to die once, and after this judgment,

28 so Christ also, having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear a second time, apart from sin, to those eagerly awaiting him, for salvation.

Chapter 10

1 For the law, having a shadow of the coming good things, not the very image of the things, can never, by the same sacrifices which they offer continually year by year, perfect those approaching.

2 Otherwise, would they not have ceased being offered, because the worshipers, having been cleansed once, would no longer have any consciousness of sins?

3 But in them there is a reminder of sins year by year.

4 For it is impossible for the blood of bulls and goats to take away sins.

5 Therefore, entering into the world, he says: Sacrifice and offering you did not desire, but a body you prepared for me.

6 In whole burnt offerings and offerings for sin you did not take pleasure.

7 Then I said: Behold, I have come, in the roll of the book it is written concerning me, to do your will, O God.

8 Saying above: Sacrifice and offering and whole burnt offerings and offerings for sin you did not desire, nor did you take pleasure in them, which are offered according to the law,

9 then he has said: Behold, I have come to do your will, O God. He takes away the first so that he may establish the second.

10 By this will we are sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.

11 And every priest indeed stands daily ministering and often offering the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins.

12 But he, having offered one sacrifice for sins continually, sat down at the right hand of God,

13 from then on awaiting until his enemies are placed as a footstool for his feet.

14 For by one offering he has perfected continually those being sanctified.

15 And the Holy Spirit also testifies to us; for after having said beforehand:

16 This is the covenant which I will make with them after those days, says the Lord: Putting my laws upon their hearts, I will also inscribe them upon their understandings,

17 and their sins and their lawless deeds I will certainly remember no more.

18 Now where there is forgiveness of these, there is no longer an offering for sin.

19 Therefore, brothers, having boldness for entrance into the holy places by the blood of Jesus,

20 which he inaugurated for us as a new and living way through the curtain, that is, his flesh,

21 and a great priest over the house of God,

22 let us approach with a true heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience and our body washed with pure water.

23 Let us hold fast the confession of hope without wavering, for the one who promised is faithful.

24 And let us consider one another for the stirring up of love and good works,

25 not abandoning the gathering together of ourselves, as is the custom of some, but encouraging, and so much more as you see the day approaching.

26 For if we sin willingly after receiving the knowledge of the truth, there no longer remains a sacrifice for sins,

27 but a certain fearful expectation of judgment and a zeal of fire about to devour the adversaries.

28 Anyone having set aside the law of Moses dies without mercies upon two or three witnesses.

29 Of how much worse punishment do you think the one will be deemed worthy who has trampled the Son of God, and regarded as common the blood of the covenant by which he was sanctified, and insulted the Spirit of grace?

30 For we know the one who said: Vengeance is mine; I will repay, says the Lord. And again: The Lord will judge his people.

31 It is fearful to fall into the hands of the living God.

32 But recall the earlier days in which, having been enlightened, you endured a great struggle of sufferings,

33 partly being publicly exposed to both reproaches and afflictions, and partly having become partners of those living thus.

34 For you also sympathized with my bonds, and accepted with joy the plundering of your possessions, knowing that you have in yourselves a better and abiding possession in the heavens.

35 Therefore do not throw away your boldness, which has a great recompense.

36 For you have need of endurance, so that, having done the will of God, you may receive the promise.

37 For yet a very little while, the coming one will come and will not delay.

38 But the righteous one will live by faith, and if he draws back, my soul takes no pleasure in him.

39 But we are not of drawing back to destruction, but of faith to the preservation of the soul.

Chapter 11

1 Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the proof of things not seen.

2 For by this the elders were testified to.

3 By faith we understand that the ages have been fitted together by the word of God, so that the things seen have not come into being from things appearing.

4 By faith Abel offered to God a greater sacrifice than Cain, through which he was testified to be righteous, God testifying concerning his gifts; and through it, having died, he is still spoken of.

5 By faith Enoch was transferred so as not to see death, and he was not found because God transferred him; for before his transfer he has been testified to have pleased God.

6 But without faith it is impossible to please him; for the one approaching God must believe that he exists and becomes a rewarder of those seeking him out.

7 By faith Noah, having been warned concerning things not yet seen, moved with reverence, prepared an ark for the salvation of his household, through which he condemned the world and became an heir of the righteousness according to faith.

8 By faith Abraham, being called, obeyed to go out to the place which he was about to receive as an inheritance, and he went out not knowing where he was going.

9 By faith he sojourned in the land of the promise as in a foreign land, dwelling in tents with Isaac and Jacob, the fellow heirs of the same promise.

10 For he was awaiting the city having the foundations, whose craftsman and maker is God.

11 By faith Sarah herself also received power for the depositing of seed, and beyond the time of age she gave birth, since she regarded the one who promised as faithful.

12 Therefore also from one, and that one having been deadened, were born as the stars of heaven in multitude and as the innumerable sand beside the lip of the sea.

13 According to faith all these died, not having received the promises, but having seen them from afar and been persuaded and greeted them, and confessed that they are strangers and sojourners upon the earth.

14 For those saying such things make evident that they seek a homeland.

15 And if indeed they were remembering that one from which they went out, they would have had opportunity to return.

16 But now they desire a better one, that is, a heavenly one; therefore God is not ashamed of them, to be called their God, for he prepared a city for them.

17 By faith Abraham, being tested, has offered Isaac, and the one who received the promises was offering his only-begotten,

18 to whom it was spoken: In Isaac a seed will be called for you,

19 reckoning that God is able even to raise from the dead, from where he also received him back in a parable.

20 By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau concerning coming things.

21 By faith Jacob, dying, blessed each of the sons of Joseph and bowed in worship upon the top of his staff.

22 By faith Joseph, coming to his end, made mention of the exodus of the sons of Israel and gave orders concerning his bones.

23 By faith Moses, having been born, was hidden for three months by his parents, because they saw that the child was beautiful, and they did not fear the decree of the king.

24 By faith Moses, having become grown, refused to be called a son of Pharaoh's daughter,

25 having chosen rather to suffer ill treatment with the people of God than to have temporary enjoyment of sin,

26 having regarded the reproach of Christ as greater wealth than the treasures in Egypt, for he was looking toward the recompense.

27 By faith he left Egypt, not fearing the wrath of the king, for he persevered as seeing the invisible one.

28 By faith he has kept the Passover and the sprinkling of the blood, so that the one destroying the firstborn might not touch them.

29 By faith they crossed the Red Sea as through dry land, of which the Egyptians, having made an attempt, were swallowed up.

30 By faith the walls of Jericho fell, having been encircled for seven days.

31 By faith Rahab the prostitute did not perish together with those who disobeyed, having received the spies with peace.

32 And what more do I say? For time will fail me while recounting concerning Gideon, and Barak and Samson and Jephthah, and David and Samuel and the prophets,

33 who through faith conquered kingdoms, worked righteousness, obtained promises, shut the mouths of lions,

34 quenched the power of fire, escaped the edges of the sword, were strengthened from weakness, became strong in war, put to flight armies of foreigners.

35 Women received their dead by resurrection; but others were tortured, not accepting release, so that they might obtain a better resurrection.

36 And others received trial of mockings and scourges, and further of bonds and imprisonment.

37 They were stoned, they were sawn apart, they were tempted, they died by slaughter of the sword; they went about in sheepskins, in goatskins, being in need, afflicted, ill-treated,

38 of whom the world was not worthy, wandering in deserts and mountains and caves and the holes of the earth.

39 And all these, having been testified to through faith, did not receive the promise,

40 God having foreseen something better concerning us, so that they might not be perfected apart from us.

Chapter 12

1 Therefore we also, having so great a cloud of witnesses surrounding us, having laid aside every weight and the easily entangling sin, let us run with endurance the contest set before us,

2 looking away to Jesus, the founder and perfecter of faith, who for the joy set before him endured a cross, despising shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God.

3 For consider the one who has endured such opposition from sinners against himself, so that you may not grow weary, fainting in your souls.

4 You have not yet resisted to the point of blood, struggling against sin.

5 And you have forgotten the exhortation which addresses you as sons: My son, do not regard lightly the discipline of the Lord, nor faint when reproved by him.

6 For whom the Lord loves he disciplines, and he scourges every son whom he receives.

7 If you endure discipline, God deals with you as sons; for what son is there whom a father does not discipline?

8 But if you are without discipline, of which all have become partakers, then you are illegitimate and not sons.

9 Furthermore, we had the fathers of our flesh as disciplinarians and respected them; will we not much more be subjected to the Father of spirits and live?

10 For they indeed disciplined for a few days according to what seemed good to them, but he for what is beneficial, for partaking of his holiness.

11 Now all discipline for the present does not seem to be of joy but of grief; but afterward it gives back a peaceful fruit of righteousness to those trained through it.

12 Therefore straighten the hanging hands and the paralyzed knees,

13 and make straight paths for your feet, so that the lame thing may not be turned aside, but rather be healed.

14 Pursue peace with all, and sanctification, without which no one will see the Lord,

15 watching lest anyone fall short of the grace of God, lest any root of bitterness growing upward cause trouble, and through this many be defiled,

16 lest anyone be a fornicator or profane like Esau, who for one meal sold his birthright.

17 For you know that even afterward, wishing to inherit the blessing, he was rejected; for he found no place for repentance, although he sought it out with tears.

18 For you have not approached a mountain that can be touched and burned with fire, and gloom and darkness and tempest,

19 and a trumpet's sound and a voice of words, which those hearing begged that no further word be added to them.

20 For they could not bear what was commanded: Even if a beast touches the mountain, it will be stoned or shot down with a missile.

21 And so fearful was what appeared that Moses said: I am terrified and trembling.

22 But you have approached Mount Zion and the city of the living God, heavenly Jerusalem, and myriads of angels,

23 a festal assembly and church of firstborn ones enrolled in the heavens, and God the judge of all, and spirits of righteous ones perfected,

24 and Jesus, mediator of a new covenant, and blood of sprinkling speaking better things than Abel.

25 See that you do not refuse the one speaking. For if those did not escape who refused the one giving warning on earth, much more we who turn away from the one from the heavens.

26 Whose voice shook the earth then, but now he has promised, saying: Yet once I shake not only the earth but also heaven.

27 Now the phrase: Yet once, indicates the removal of the things shaken, as things made, so that the things not shaken may remain.

28 Therefore, receiving an unshakable kingdom, let us have grace, through which we may serve God acceptably with modesty and reverence.

29 For our God is also a consuming fire.

Chapter 13

1 Let brotherly love remain.

2 Do not forget hospitality, for through this some entertained angels without knowing it.

3 Remember the prisoners as bound together with them, those being ill-treated as being yourselves also in a body.

4 Marriage is honorable among all, and the bed undefiled; but fornicators and adulterers God will judge.

5 Let your manner be without love of money, being content with the things present; for he himself has said: I will certainly not leave you, nor will I certainly abandon you.

6 So that, being confident, we say: The Lord is my helper, and I will not fear; what will man do to me?

7 Remember your leaders, who spoke the word of God to you, whose faith imitate, considering the outcome of their conduct.

8 Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever.

9 Do not be carried about by various and foreign teachings; for it is good for the heart to be established by grace, not by foods, in which those who walked were not benefited.

10 We have an altar from which those serving the tent have no authority to eat.

11 For the bodies of those animals whose blood is brought into the holy places for sin through the high priest are burned outside the camp.

12 Therefore Jesus also, so that he might sanctify the people through his own blood, suffered outside the gate.

13 Therefore let us go out to him outside the camp, bearing his reproach.

14 For we do not have here an abiding city, but we seek the coming one.

15 Through him therefore let us continually offer a sacrifice of praise to God, that is, fruit of lips confessing his name.

16 But do not forget doing good and sharing, for with such sacrifices God is pleased.

17 Obey your leaders and yield, for they keep watch over your souls as those who will give an account, so that they may do this with joy and not groaning, for this is unprofitable for you.

18 Pray concerning us, for we are persuaded that we have a good conscience, wishing to conduct ourselves well in all things.

19 But I more abundantly urge you to do this, so that I may be restored to you more quickly.

20 Now the God of peace, who brought up from the dead the great shepherd of the sheep, in the blood of an eternal covenant, our Lord Jesus,

21 may he fit you in every good work to do his will, doing in you what is pleasing before him through Jesus Christ, to whom be the glory forever and ever. Amen.

22 But I urge you, brothers, bear with the word of exhortation, for I have also written to you briefly.

23 Know that our brother Timothy has been released, with whom, if he comes more quickly, I will see you.

24 Greet all your leaders and all the saints. Those from Italy greet you.

25 Grace be with all of you. Amen.

James

Chapter 1

1 James, a slave of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, to the twelve tribes in the dispersion: Greetings.

2 Consider it all joy, my brothers, whenever you fall into various trials,

3 knowing that the testing of your faith produces endurance.

4 But let endurance have a perfect work, so that you may be perfect and complete, lacking in nothing.

5 But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him ask from God, who gives to all generously and does not reproach, and it will be given to him.

6 But let him ask in faith, doubting nothing; for the one doubting resembles a wave of the sea driven and tossed by wind.

7 For let that man not suppose that he will receive anything from the Lord,

8 a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways.

9 But let the lowly brother boast in his elevation,

10 and the rich in his humiliation, because like a flower of grass he will pass away.

11 For the sun rose with the scorching heat and dried the grass, and its flower fell off, and the beauty of its appearance perished; so also the rich man will wither in his journeys.

12 Blessed is a man who endures trial, because, having become approved, he will receive the crown of life which the Lord promised to those loving him.

13 Let no one being tempted say: I am tempted by God; for God is not tempted by evils, and he himself tempts no one.

14 But each is tempted, being drawn out and enticed by his own desire.

15 Then desire, having conceived, gives birth to sin; and sin, having been completed, brings forth death.

16 Do not be deceived, my beloved brothers.

17 Every good giving and every perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shadow of turning.

18 Having willed it, he brought us forth by a word of truth, so that we might be a kind of firstfruits of his creatures.

19 Therefore, my beloved brothers, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath.

20 For a man's wrath does not produce God's righteousness.

21 Therefore, laying aside all filthiness and abundance of wickedness, receive in gentleness the implanted word, which is able to save your souls.

22 But become doers of the word and not hearers only, deceiving yourselves.

23 Because if anyone is a hearer of the word and not a doer, he resembles a man considering the face of his birth in a mirror.

24 For he considered himself and has gone away, and immediately forgot what he was like.

25 But the one having looked into the perfect law, that of freedom, and remained, this one, having become not a forgetful hearer but a doer of work, will be blessed in his doing.

26 If anyone among you seems to be religious, not bridling his tongue but deceiving his heart, this one's religion is vain.

27 Religion pure and undefiled before God and the Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in their affliction, to keep oneself unspotted from the world.

Chapter 2

1 My brothers, do not hold the faith of our Lord Jesus Christ of glory with partialities.

2 For if a man with a gold ring enters your assembly in splendid clothing, and a poor man also enters in filthy clothing,

3 and you look upon the one wearing the splendid clothing and say to him: You sit here in a good place; and to the poor man you say: You stand there, or sit here beneath my footstool,

4 have you not also made distinctions among yourselves and become judges of evil reasonings?

5 Listen, my beloved brothers: Did not God choose the poor of this world, rich in faith and heirs of the kingdom which he promised to those loving him?

6 But you dishonored the poor man. Do not the rich oppress you, and do they themselves not drag you into courts?

7 Do they themselves not blaspheme the good name invoked upon you?

8 If indeed you fulfill the royal law according to the Scripture: You shall love your neighbor as yourself, you do well.

9 But if you show partiality, you work sin, being convicted by the law as transgressors.

10 For whoever will keep the whole law but stumble in one thing has become guilty of all.

11 For the one who said: Do not commit adultery, also said: Do not murder. But if you will not commit adultery, but will murder, you have become a transgressor of law.

12 So speak and so do, as those about to be judged through a law of freedom.

13 For judgment is merciless to the one who has not done mercy, and mercy boasts over judgment.

14 What is the benefit, my brothers, if anyone says he has faith but does not have works? Can faith save him?

15 But if a brother or sister are naked and lacking daily food,

16 and anyone among you says to them: Go in peace, be warmed and filled, but you do not give them the necessities of the body, what is the benefit?

17 So also faith, if it does not have works, is dead by itself.

18 But someone will say: You have faith, and I have works. Show me your faith from your works, and I will show you my faith from my works.

19 You believe that God is one; you do well. The demons also believe and shudder.

20 But do you wish to know, O empty man, that faith apart from works is dead?

21 Was not Abraham our father justified from works, having offered Isaac his son upon the altar?

22 You see that faith was working together with his works, and from the works faith was perfected.

23 And the Scripture was fulfilled which says: Abraham believed God, and it was reckoned to him as righteousness; and he was called a friend of God.

24 Therefore you see that a man is justified from works and not from faith alone.

25 And likewise was not Rahab the prostitute also justified from works, having received the messengers and sent them out by another way?

26 For just as the body apart from spirit is dead, so also faith apart from works is dead.

Chapter 3

1 Do not become many teachers, my brothers, knowing that we will receive a greater judgment.

2 For we all stumble in many things. If anyone does not stumble in word, this one is a perfect man, able to bridle also the whole body.

3 Behold, we put the bridles into the mouths of horses so that they obey us, and we direct their whole body.

4 Behold also the ships, being so great and driven by harsh winds, are directed by a very small rudder wherever the impulse of the one steering wishes.

5 So also the tongue is a small member and boasts greatly. Behold, how small a fire kindles how great a forest!

6 And the tongue is a fire, the world of unrighteousness. So the tongue is set among our members, staining the whole body and setting on fire the wheel of birth, and being set on fire by Gehenna.

7 For every nature of both beasts and birds, both reptiles and sea creatures, is tamed and has been tamed by human nature.

8 But no one among men can tame the tongue, an unrestrainable evil, full of death-bearing poison.

9 With it we bless God and the Father, and with it we curse men who have been made according to God's likeness.

10 From the same mouth come out blessing and curse. These things ought not to happen thus, my brothers.

11 Does the spring from the same opening pour forth the sweet and the bitter?

12 Can a fig tree, my brothers, produce olives, or a vine figs? So no spring can produce salty and sweet water.

13 Who is wise and knowledgeable among you? Let him show from good conduct his works in gentleness of wisdom.

14 But if you have bitter jealousy and selfish ambition in your heart, do not boast and lie against the truth.

15 This is not the wisdom coming down from above, but earthly, natural, demonic.

16 For where there are jealousy and selfish ambition, there are disorder and every base thing.

17 But the wisdom from above is first pure, then peaceable, forbearing, readily persuaded, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality and without hypocrisy.

18 And a fruit of righteousness is sown in peace by those making peace.

Chapter 4

1 From where are wars and battles among you? Are they not from here, from your pleasures waging war in your members?

2 You desire and do not have; you murder and are jealous and cannot obtain; you battle and wage war. But you do not have because you do not ask.

3 You ask and do not receive because you ask badly, so that you may spend on your pleasures.

4 Adulterers and adulteresses, do you not know that friendship with the world is enmity with God? Therefore whoever wishes to be a friend of the world is made an enemy of God.

5 Or do you think that the Scripture speaks vainly: The spirit which dwelt in us yearns toward envy?

6 But he gives greater grace; therefore he says: God opposes the proud, but gives grace to the humble.

7 Therefore be subjected to God; resist the devil, and he will flee from you.

8 Draw near to God, and he will draw near to you. Cleanse your hands, sinners, and purify your hearts, double-minded ones.

9 Be miserable and mourn and weep. Let your laughter be turned to mourning and your joy to dejection.

10 Be humbled before the Lord, and he will exalt you.

11 Do not speak against one another, brothers. The one speaking against a brother and judging his brother speaks against law and judges law. But if you judge law, you are not a doer of law but a judge.

12 There is one lawgiver, the one able to save and destroy. Who are you who judge the other?

13 Come now, those saying: Today and tomorrow let us go to this city and spend one year there and trade and gain,

14 who do not know the thing of tomorrow. For what is your life? For it is a vapor appearing for a little while, then disappearing.

15 Instead of your saying: If the Lord wills, we shall both live and do this or that.

16 But now you boast in your arrogances. All such boasting is evil.

17 Therefore to one knowing to do good and not doing it, it is sin to him.

Chapter 5

1 Come now, the rich, weep, howling over your coming miseries.

2 Your wealth has rotted, and your garments have become moth-eaten.

3 Your gold and silver have corroded, and their rust will be a testimony to you and will eat your flesh like fire. You stored up treasure in the last days.

4 Behold, the wage of the workers who reaped your fields, withheld by you, cries out, and the cries of those who harvested have entered into the ears of the Lord of hosts.

5 You lived luxuriously upon the earth and indulged yourselves; you nourished your hearts as in a day of slaughter.

6 You condemned, you murdered the righteous one; he does not oppose you.

7 Therefore be patient, brothers, until the coming of the Lord. Behold, the farmer awaits the precious fruit of the earth, being patient over it until he receives early and late rain.

8 You also be patient; establish your hearts, because the coming of the Lord has drawn near.

9 Do not groan against one another, brothers, so that you may not be condemned. Behold, a judge has stood before the doors.

10 Take as an example of suffering and patience, my brothers, the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord.

11 Behold, we call blessed those enduring. You heard the endurance of Job and saw the end of the Lord, that the Lord is very compassionate and merciful.

12 But before all things, my brothers, do not swear, neither by heaven nor by earth nor any other oath; but let your yes be yes and your no be no, so that you may not fall into hypocrisy.

13 Does anyone among you suffer? Let him pray. Is anyone cheerful? Let him sing praise.

14 Is anyone among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the church, and let them pray over him, having anointed him with oil in the name of the Lord.

15 And the prayer of faith will save the one suffering, and the Lord will raise him; and even if he has committed sins, it will be forgiven him.

16 Confess to one another the trespasses, and pray for one another so that you may be healed. A righteous man's petition has much strength when at work.

17 Elijah was a man of like passions with us, and with prayer he prayed that it not rain, and it did not rain upon the earth for three years and six months.

18 And again he prayed, and heaven gave rain, and the earth sprouted its fruit.

19 Brothers, if anyone among you wanders from the truth and someone turns him back,

20 let him know that the one turning a sinner back from the wandering of his way will save a soul from death and cover a multitude of sins.

1 Peter

Chapter 1

1 Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ, to chosen sojourners of the dispersion of Pontus, Galatia, Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,

2 according to the foreknowledge of God the Father, in sanctification of the Spirit, for obedience and sprinkling of the blood of Jesus Christ: May grace and peace be multiplied to you.

3 Blessed is the God and Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who according to his abundant mercy begot us again to a living hope through the resurrection of Jesus Christ from the dead,

4 to an inheritance incorruptible and undefiled and unfading, kept in the heavens for us,

5 who are guarded by the power of God through faith for salvation ready to be revealed in the last time.

6 In which you rejoice, having now for a little while, if it is necessary, been grieved in various trials,

7 so that the testing of your faith, much more precious than gold which perishes but is tested through fire, may be found for praise and honor and glory at the revelation of Jesus Christ,

8 whom, not having seen, you love; in whom, now not seeing but believing, you rejoice with inexpressible and glorified joy,

9 receiving the end of your faith, salvation of souls.

10 Concerning which salvation prophets sought out and searched out, who prophesied concerning the grace toward you,

11 searching into what or what kind of time the Spirit of Christ in them was indicating, testifying beforehand the sufferings for Christ and the glories after these.

12 To whom it was revealed that not to themselves but to us they were ministering these things, which have now been announced to you through those who proclaimed the good news to you in the Holy Spirit sent from heaven, into which angels desire to look.

13 Therefore, girding up the loins of your understanding, being sober, hope completely upon the grace being brought to you at the revelation of Jesus Christ,

14 as children of obedience, not conforming yourselves to the former desires in your ignorance,

15 but according to the holy one who called you, become holy yourselves also in all conduct,

16 because it is written: Become holy, because I am holy.

17 And if you invoke as Father the one judging without partiality according to each one's work, conduct the time of your sojourning in fear,

18 knowing that you were redeemed not with corruptible things, silver or gold, from your vain conduct handed down from fathers,

19 but with precious blood, as of a lamb without blemish and unspotted, of Christ,

20 indeed foreknown before the foundation of the world, but manifested at the last of the times because of you,

21 who through him believe in God, who raised him from the dead and gave him glory, so that your faith and hope might be in God.

22 Having purified your souls in obedience to the truth through the Spirit for unhypocritical brotherly love, love one another earnestly from a pure heart,

23 having been begotten again, not from corruptible seed but incorruptible, through the living word of God, which also remains forever.

24 Because all flesh is like grass, and all glory of man like a flower of grass; the grass was dried and its flower fell off,

25 but the word of the Lord remains forever. And this is the word proclaimed as good news to you.

Chapter 2

1 Therefore, laying aside all wickedness and all deceit and hypocrisies and envies and all evil speakings,

2 as newborn infants, desire the pure rational milk, so that by it you may grow,

3 if indeed you tasted that the Lord is kind.

4 Approaching him, a living stone, indeed rejected by men but chosen and honorable before God,

5 you yourselves also, as living stones, are being built as a spiritual house, a holy priesthood, to offer spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ.

6 Therefore it also contains in the Scripture: Behold, I place in Zion a cornerstone, chosen, honorable, and the one believing upon him will certainly not be put to shame.

7 Therefore the honor is to you who believe; but to those disobeying: The stone which the builders rejected, this became the head of the corner,

8 and a stone of stumbling and a rock of offense; who stumble at the word, disobeying, to which they were also appointed.

9 But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for possession, so that you may proclaim the excellences of the one who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light,

10 who once were not a people, but now a people of God; who had not received mercy, but now have received mercy.

11 Beloved, I urge you as strangers and sojourners to abstain from fleshly desires, which wage war against the soul,

12 having your conduct good among the nations, so that in what they speak against you as evildoers, having observed the good works, they may glorify God in a day of visitation.

13 Therefore be subjected to every human institution because of the Lord, whether to a king as being superior,

14 or to governors as sent through him for vengeance upon evildoers but praise of those doing good.

15 Because thus is the will of God, by doing good to muzzle the ignorance of foolish men,

16 as free, and not having freedom as a covering of wickedness, but as slaves of God.

17 Honor all; love the brotherhood; fear God; honor the king.

18 Household slaves, being subjected with all fear to the masters, not only to the good and forbearing but also to the crooked.

19 For this is grace, if because of consciousness of God someone bears griefs, suffering unjustly.

20 For what credit is there if, sinning and being struck, you endure? But if, doing good and suffering, you endure, this is grace before God.

21 For to this you were called, because Christ also suffered on our behalf, leaving us an example so that you might follow his footsteps,

22 who did not commit sin, nor was deceit found in his mouth,

23 who, being reviled, did not revile in return; suffering, did not threaten, but entrusted to the one judging righteously,

24 who himself bore our sins in his body upon the wood, so that, having departed from sins, we might live to righteousness; by whose wound you were healed.

25 For you were like wandering sheep, but now you turned back to the shepherd and overseer of your souls.

Chapter 3

1 Likewise, wives, being subjected to your own husbands, so that even if any disobey the word, through the conduct of the wives they may be gained without a word,

2 having observed your pure conduct in fear.

3 Whose adornment let it not be the outward one of braiding hair and putting around gold ornaments or putting on garments,

4 but the hidden man of the heart, in the incorruptibility of the gentle and quiet spirit, which is very precious before God.

5 For thus once also the holy women hoping upon God adorned themselves, being subjected to their own husbands,

6 as Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him lord, whose children you became, doing good and not fearing any terror.

7 Husbands likewise, dwelling together according to knowledge, apportioning honor to the female as a weaker vessel, as also fellow heirs of the grace of life, so that your prayers may not be cut off.

8 And finally, all be of one mind, sympathetic, loving brothers, compassionate, friendly,

9 not giving back evil for evil or reviling for reviling, but on the contrary blessing, knowing that to this you were called, so that you might inherit a blessing.

10 For the one wishing to love life and see good days, let him stop his tongue from evil and his lips from speaking deceit.

11 Let him turn away from evil and do good; let him seek peace and pursue it.

12 Because the eyes of the Lord are upon the righteous, and his ears toward their petition, but the face of the Lord is upon those doing evils.

13 And who is the one who will harm you if you become imitators of the good?

14 But even if you should suffer because of righteousness, you are blessed. But do not fear their fear, nor be troubled.

15 But sanctify the Lord God in your hearts, and be always ready for a defense to everyone asking you an account concerning the hope in you, with gentleness and fear,

16 having a good conscience, so that in what they speak against you as evildoers, those abusing your good conduct in Christ may be put to shame.

17 For it is better, doing good, if the will of God wills it, to suffer than doing evil.

18 Because Christ also suffered once for sins, righteous on behalf of unrighteous, so that he might bring us to God, indeed put to death in flesh but made alive in the Spirit,

19 in which also, having gone, he proclaimed to the spirits in prison,

20 who once disobeyed, when once the patience of God was waiting in the days of Noah, an ark being prepared, into which a few, that is, eight souls, were brought safely through water.

21 Which also now saves us as a counterpart, baptism, not a removal of dirt of flesh, but a request of a good conscience toward God, through the resurrection of Jesus Christ,

22 who is at the right hand of God, having gone into heaven, angels and authorities and powers having been subjected to him.

Chapter 4

1 Therefore, Christ having suffered for us in flesh, you also arm yourselves with the same thought, because the one having suffered in flesh has ceased from sin,

2 to live the remaining time in flesh no longer for men's desires but for God's will.

3 For the past time of life is sufficient for us to have worked the will of the nations, having walked in licentiousness, desires, drunkenness, revelries, drinking parties, and unlawful idolatries,

4 in which they are surprised that you do not run together into the same outpouring of dissipation, blaspheming,

5 who will give an account to the one ready to judge living and dead.

6 For to this end the good news was also proclaimed to the dead, so that they might indeed be judged according to men in flesh, but live according to God in spirit.

7 But the end of all things has drawn near. Therefore be sound-minded and sober for prayers.

8 But before all things, having earnest love toward yourselves, because love will cover a multitude of sins.

9 Be hospitable to one another without murmurings.

10 Each, as he received a gift, ministering it to yourselves as good stewards of the varied grace of God.

11 If anyone speaks, as oracles of God; if anyone ministers, as from strength which God supplies, so that in all things God may be glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom are the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

12 Beloved, do not be surprised at the burning among you occurring for your trial, as though a strange thing were happening to you,

13 but insofar as you partake of the sufferings of Christ, rejoice, so that also at the revelation of his glory you may rejoice, exulting.

14 If you are reproached in the name of Christ, you are blessed, because the Spirit of glory and of God rests upon you; on their part he is blasphemed, but on your part he is glorified.

15 For let none of you suffer as a murderer or thief or evildoer, or as an overseer of others' affairs.

16 But if as a Christian, let him not be ashamed, but let him glorify God in this matter.

17 Because it is the time for judgment to begin from the house of God; but if first from us, what is the end of those disobeying the good news of God?

18 And if the righteous one is scarcely saved, where will the ungodly and sinner appear?

19 Therefore also let those suffering according to the will of God entrust their own souls to a faithful creator in doing good.

Chapter 5

1 I urge the elders among you, as a fellow elder and witness of the sufferings of Christ, also a partaker of the glory about to be revealed:

2 Shepherd the flock of God among you, overseeing not by compulsion but willingly, nor for shameful gain but eagerly,

3 nor as lording over the allotted portions, but becoming examples of the flock.

4 And when the chief shepherd has been manifested, you will receive the unfading crown of glory.

5 Likewise, younger ones, be subjected to elders; and all, being subjected to one another, clothe yourselves with humility, because God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble.

6 Therefore be humbled under the mighty hand of God, so that he may exalt you in time,

7 having cast all your anxiety upon him, because he cares concerning you.

8 Be sober, keep watch, because your adversary the devil walks about as a roaring lion, seeking someone he may swallow.

9 Resist him, firm in faith, knowing that the same sufferings are being accomplished in your brotherhood in the world.

10 But the God of all grace, who called us into his eternal glory in Christ Jesus, after you have suffered a little, may he himself fit you, establish, strengthen, found you.

11 To him be the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

12 Through Silvanus, the faithful brother to you, as I reckon, I wrote briefly, urging and further testifying that this is the true grace of God, in which you have stood.

13 The one in Babylon chosen together with you greets you, and Mark my son.

14 Greet one another with a kiss of love. Peace to all of you in Christ Jesus. Amen.

2 Peter

Chapter 1

1 Simeon Peter, a slave and apostle of Jesus Christ, to those who obtained a faith equally precious with ours in the righteousness of our God and Savior Jesus Christ:

2 May grace and peace be multiplied to you in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our Lord,

3 as his divine power has given us all things pertaining to life and godliness, through the knowledge of the one who called us through glory and excellence,

4 through which the greatest and precious promises have been given to us, so that through these you may become partakers of divine nature, having escaped the corruption in the world in desire.

5 And for this very thing also, bringing in all diligence, supply in your faith excellence, and in excellence knowledge,

6 and in knowledge self-control, and in self-control endurance, and in endurance godliness,

7 and in godliness brotherly love, and in brotherly love love.

8 For these things, belonging to you and increasing, make you neither idle nor unfruitful toward the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.

9 For the one to whom these things are not present is blind, being shortsighted, having taken forgetfulness of the cleansing of his former sins.

10 Therefore rather, brothers, be diligent to make your calling and election firm, for doing these things you will certainly never stumble.

11 For thus the entrance into the eternal kingdom of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ will be richly supplied to you.

12 Therefore I will not neglect always to remind you concerning these things, although you know and have been established in the present truth.

13 But I consider it right, as long as I am in this tent, to stir you up by reminder,

14 knowing that the putting off of my tent is soon, as also our Lord Jesus Christ indicated to me.

15 But I will also be diligent that after my departure you may at each time be able to make remembrance of these things.

16 For not having followed cleverly devised myths did we make known to you the power and coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, but having become eyewitnesses of his majesty.

17 For having received honor and glory from God the Father, such a voice having been brought to him by the magnificent glory: This is my beloved Son, in whom I took pleasure,

18 and we heard this voice brought from heaven, being with him on the holy mountain.

19 And we have the prophetic word firmer, to which you do well to pay attention as to a lamp shining in a murky place, until day shines through and the light-bearer rises in your hearts,

20 knowing this first, that no prophecy of Scripture comes from its own interpretation.

21 For prophecy was never brought by man's will, but the holy men of God spoke, being carried by the Holy Spirit.

Chapter 2

1 But there also arose false prophets among the people, as there will also be false teachers among you, who will secretly bring in heresies of destruction, even denying the master who bought them, bringing upon themselves swift destruction.

2 And many will follow their destructions, because of whom the way of truth will be blasphemed.

3 And in greed they will trade in you with fabricated words, for whom the judgment from long ago is not idle, and their destruction does not slumber.

4 For if God did not spare angels having sinned, but having cast them into Tartarus with chains of gloom, handed them over, kept for judgment,

5 and did not spare the ancient world, but guarded Noah, an eighth, a herald of righteousness, having brought a flood upon a world of ungodly ones,

6 and having reduced the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah to ashes, condemned them to overthrow, having set an example of those about to be ungodly,

7 and rescued righteous Lot, being oppressed by the conduct of the lawless in licentiousness,

8 for by sight and hearing the righteous one, dwelling among them, was tormenting a righteous soul day after day with lawless works,

9 the Lord knows how to rescue godly ones out of trial, but to keep unrighteous ones being punished for a day of judgment,

10 and especially those going after flesh in desire of defilement and despising lordship. Daring, self-willed, they do not tremble, blaspheming glories,

11 whereas angels, being greater in strength and power, do not bring a blasphemous judgment against them before the Lord.

12 But these, like irrational natural animals born for capture and corruption, blaspheming in things they do not know, will be utterly corrupted in their corruption,

13 receiving a wage of unrighteousness, considering luxury in daytime a pleasure, spots and blemishes, reveling in their deceits, feasting together with you,

14 having eyes full of an adulteress and unceasing from sin, enticing unstable souls, having a heart trained in greeds, children of a curse.

15 Having left the straight way, they wandered, having followed the way of Balaam of Bosor, who loved a wage of unrighteousness.

16 But he had a rebuke of his own lawlessness: a voiceless beast of burden, having spoken with a man's voice, restrained the prophet's madness.

17 These are waterless springs, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the gloom of darkness has been kept forever.

18 For speaking swollen things of vanity, they entice in fleshly desires, in licentiousness, those who truly escaped those conducting themselves in wandering,

19 promising them freedom, themselves being slaves of corruption; for by what someone has been overcome, by this he has also been enslaved.

20 For if, having escaped the defilements of the world in the knowledge of the Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, but having again become entangled in these, they are overcome, their last things have become worse than the first.

21 For it was better for them not to have known the way of righteousness than, having known it, to turn back from the holy commandment handed down to them.

22 But the thing of the true proverb has happened to them: A dog having returned to its own vomit, and a sow having washed, to a rolling in mud.

Chapter 3

1 This is already a second letter I write to you, beloved, in which I stir up your sincere understanding by reminder,

2 to remember the words spoken beforehand by the holy prophets, and the commandment of the Lord and Savior from our apostles,

3 knowing this first, that mockers will come at the last of the days, walking according to their own desires,

4 and saying: Where is the promise of his coming? For since the fathers fell asleep, all things remain thus from the beginning of creation.

5 For this escapes them willingly, that heavens existed long ago, and earth standing together out of water and through water by the word of God,

6 through which the world then, having been flooded with water, perished.

7 But the present heavens and earth have been stored up by his word for fire, being kept for a day of judgment and destruction of ungodly men.

8 But let this one thing not escape you, beloved, that one day before the Lord is as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day.

9 The Lord does not delay the promise, as some consider delay, but is patient toward us, not wishing any to perish but all to come to repentance.

10 But the day of the Lord will come as a thief in the night, in which the heavens will pass away with a rushing sound, and the elements, burning, will be dissolved, and earth and the works in it will be burned up.

11 Therefore, all these things being dissolved, what kind ought you to be in holy conducts and godlinesses,

12 expecting and hastening the coming of the day of God, because of which heavens being set on fire will be dissolved, and elements burning melt.

13 But according to his promise we expect new heavens and a new earth, in which righteousness dwells.

14 Therefore, beloved, expecting these things, be diligent to be found by him unspotted and blameless in peace,

15 and consider the patience of our Lord salvation, as also our beloved brother Paul, according to the wisdom given to him, wrote to you,

16 as also in all the letters, speaking in them concerning these things, in which are some things difficult to understand, which the unlearned and unstable twist, as also the remaining Scriptures, toward their own destruction.

17 Therefore you, beloved, knowing beforehand, guard yourselves so that, being carried away together by the wandering of the lawless, you may not fall from your own firmness.

18 But grow in grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To him be the glory both now and to a day of eternity. Amen.

1 John

Chapter 1

1 What was from the beginning, what we have heard, what we have seen with our eyes, what we beheld and our hands touched, concerning the word of life,

2 and the life was manifested, and we have seen and testify and announce to you the eternal life, which was with the Father and was manifested to us,

3 what we have seen and heard we announce to you, so that you also may have fellowship with us; and our fellowship is also with the Father and with his Son Jesus Christ.

4 And these things we write to you so that our joy may be fulfilled.

5 And this is the promise which we have heard from him and report to you, that God is light, and there is no darkness at all in him.

6 If we say that we have fellowship with him and walk in darkness, we lie and do not do the truth.

7 But if we walk in the light, as he is in the light, we have fellowship with one another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his Son cleanses us from every sin.

8 If we say that we do not have sin, we deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in us.

9 If we confess our sins, he is faithful and righteous to forgive us the sins and cleanse us from every unrighteousness.

10 If we say that we have not sinned, we make him a liar, and his word is not in us.

Chapter 2

1 My little children, these things I write to you so that you may not sin. And if anyone sins, we have an advocate with the Father, Jesus Christ the righteous.

2 And he is atonement concerning our sins, but not concerning ours only, but also concerning the whole world.

3 And by this we know that we have known him, if we keep his commandments.

4 The one saying: I have known him, and not keeping his commandments, is a liar, and in this one the truth is not.

5 But whoever keeps his word, truly in this one the love of God has been perfected. By this we know that we are in him.

6 The one saying he remains in him ought himself also to walk thus, just as that one walked.

7 Brothers, I do not write a new commandment to you, but an old commandment which you had from the beginning; the old commandment is the word which you heard from the beginning.

8 Again I write a new commandment to you, which is true in him and in you, because the darkness is passing away and the true light already shines.

9 The one saying he is in the light and hating his brother is in the darkness until now.

10 The one loving his brother remains in the light, and there is no stumbling block in him.

11 But the one hating his brother is in the darkness and walks in the darkness, and does not know where he goes, because the darkness blinded his eyes.

12 I write to you, little children, because the sins have been forgiven you because of his name.

13 I write to you, fathers, because you have known the one from the beginning. I write to you, young men, because you have overcome the evil one. I write to you, children, because you have known the Father.

14 I wrote to you, fathers, because you have known the one from the beginning. I wrote to you, young men, because you are strong, and the word of God remains in you, and you have overcome the evil one.

15 Do not love the world nor the things in the world. If anyone loves the world, the love of the Father is not in him.

16 Because everything in the world, the desire of the flesh and the desire of the eyes and the arrogance of life, is not from the Father but is from the world.

17 And the world is passing away, and its desire; but the one doing the will of God remains forever.

18 Children, it is a last hour; and as you heard that the antichrist is coming, even now many antichrists have arisen, from which we know that it is a last hour.

19 They went out from us, but they were not from us; for if they were from us, they would have remained with us, but so that they might be manifested, that not all are from us.

20 And you have an anointing from the Holy One, and you know all things.

21 I did not write to you because you do not know the truth, but because you know it, and because every lie is not from the truth.

22 Who is the liar if not the one denying that Jesus is the Christ? This is the antichrist, the one denying the Father and the Son.

23 Everyone denying the Son does not have the Father either.

24 Therefore you, let what you heard from the beginning remain in you. If what you heard from the beginning remains in you, you also will remain in the Son and in the Father.

25 And this is the promise which he himself promised us, the eternal life.

26 These things I wrote to you concerning those deceiving you.

27 And you, the anointing which you received from him remains in you, and you have no need that anyone teach you; but as the same anointing teaches you concerning all things, and is true and is not a lie, and as it taught you, you will remain in him.

28 And now, little children, remain in him, so that when he is manifested we may have boldness and not be put to shame away from him at his coming.

29 If you know that he is righteous, you know that everyone doing righteousness has been begotten from him.

Chapter 3

1 See what kind of love the Father has given us, so that we may be called children of God. Because of this the world does not know us, because it did not know him.

2 Beloved, now we are children of God, and it has not yet been manifested what we will be; but we know that if he is manifested, we will be like him, because we will see him as he is.

3 And everyone having this hope upon him purifies himself, just as that one is pure.

4 Everyone doing sin also does lawlessness, and sin is lawlessness.

5 And you know that that one was manifested so that he might take away our sins, and sin is not in him.

6 Everyone remaining in him does not sin; everyone sinning has not seen him nor known him.

7 Little children, let no one deceive you. The one doing righteousness is righteous, just as that one is righteous.

8 The one doing sin is from the devil, because from the beginning the devil sins. For this the Son of God was manifested, so that he might dissolve the works of the devil.

9 Everyone begotten from God does not do sin, because his seed remains in him; and he cannot sin, because he has been begotten from God.

10 By this the children of God and the children of the devil are manifest: everyone not doing righteousness is not from God, and the one not loving his brother.

11 Because this is the message which you heard from the beginning, that we should love one another,

12 not as Cain was from the evil one and slaughtered his brother. And for what reason did he slaughter him? Because his works were evil, but those of his brother righteous.

13 Do not marvel, my brothers, if the world hates you.

14 We know that we have passed from death into life, because we love the brothers. The one not loving the brother remains in death.

15 Everyone hating his brother is a murderer, and you know that every murderer does not have eternal life remaining in him.

16 By this we have known love, because that one laid down his soul for us; and we ought to lay down our souls for the brothers.

17 But whoever has the livelihood of the world, and sees his brother having need, and closes his inward parts against him, how does the love of God remain in him?

18 My little children, let us not love in word nor in tongue, but in work and truth.

19 And by this we know that we are from the truth, and before him we will persuade our hearts,

20 because if our heart condemns us, God is greater than our heart and knows all things.

21 Beloved, if our heart does not condemn us, we have boldness toward God,

22 and whatever we ask we receive from him, because we keep his commandments and do the things pleasing before him.

23 And this is his commandment, that we should believe in the name of his Son Jesus Christ and love one another, as he gave us commandment.

24 And the one keeping his commandments remains in him, and he in him; and by this we know that he remains in us, from the Spirit which he gave us.

Chapter 4

1 Beloved, do not believe every spirit, but test the spirits, whether they are from God, because many false prophets have gone out into the world.

2 By this know the Spirit of God: every spirit confessing Jesus Christ having come in flesh is from God.

3 And every spirit not confessing Jesus Christ having come in flesh is not from God; and this is that of the antichrist, which you have heard is coming, and now is already in the world.

4 You are from God, little children, and have overcome them, because the one in you is greater than the one in the world.

5 They are from the world; because of this they speak from the world, and the world hears them.

6 We are from God. The one knowing God hears us; the one who is not from God does not hear us. From this we know the Spirit of truth and the spirit of wandering.

7 Beloved, let us love one another, because love is from God, and everyone loving has been begotten from God and knows God.

8 The one not loving did not know God, because God is love.

9 In this the love of God was manifested in us, that God has sent his only-begotten Son into the world so that we may live through him.

10 In this is love, not that we loved God, but that he loved us and sent his Son as atonement concerning our sins.

11 Beloved, if God thus loved us, we also ought to love one another.

12 No one has ever beheld God. If we love one another, God remains in us, and his love is perfected in us.

13 By this we know that we remain in him and he in us, because he has given us from his Spirit.

14 And we have beheld and testify that the Father has sent the Son as Savior of the world.

15 Whoever confesses that Jesus is the Son of God, God remains in him and he in God.

16 And we have known and believed the love which God has in us. God is love, and the one remaining in love remains in God, and God in him.

17 In this love has been perfected with us, so that we may have boldness in the day of judgment, because as that one is, we also are in this world.

18 There is no fear in love, but perfect love casts fear outside, because fear has punishment; but the one fearing has not been perfected in love.

19 We love him because he first loved us.

20 If anyone says: I love God, and hates his brother, he is a liar; for the one not loving his brother whom he has seen, how can he love God whom he has not seen?

21 And this commandment we have from him, that the one loving God should also love his brother.

Chapter 5

1 Everyone believing that Jesus is the Christ has been begotten from God, and everyone loving the one who begot also loves the one begotten from him.

2 By this we know that we love the children of God, when we love God and keep his commandments.

3 For this is the love of God, that we keep his commandments; and his commandments are not heavy.

4 Because everything begotten from God overcomes the world; and this is the victory which overcame the world, our faith.

5 Who is the one overcoming the world if not the one believing that Jesus is the Son of God?

6 This is the one who came through water and blood, Jesus the Christ; not in the water only, but in the water and in the blood. And the Spirit is the one testifying, because the Spirit is the truth.

7 Because there are three testifying in heaven, the Father, the Word, and the Holy Spirit, and these three are one.

8 And there are three testifying on earth, the Spirit and the water and the blood, and the three are unto the one.

9 If we receive the testimony of men, the testimony of God is greater, because this is the testimony of God which he has testified concerning his Son.

10 The one believing in the Son of God has the testimony in himself; the one not believing God has made him a liar, because he has not believed in the testimony which God has testified concerning his Son.

11 And this is the testimony, that God gave us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.

12 The one having the Son has life; the one not having the Son of God does not have life.

13 These things I wrote to you who believe in the name of the Son of God, so that you may know that you have eternal life, and so that you may believe in the name of the Son of God.

14 And this is the boldness which we have toward him, that if we ask anything according to his will, he hears us.

15 And if we know that he hears us, whatever we ask, we know that we have the requests which we have asked from him.

16 If anyone sees his brother sinning a sin not unto death, he will ask, and he will give him life, to those sinning not unto death. There is a sin unto death; not concerning that do I say that he should ask.

17 All unrighteousness is sin, and there is sin not unto death.

18 We know that everyone begotten from God does not sin, but the one begotten from God keeps himself, and the evil one does not touch him.

19 We know that we are from God, and the whole world lies in the evil one.

20 But we know that the Son of God has come and has given us understanding, so that we may know the true one; and we are in the true one, in his Son Jesus Christ. This is the true God and eternal life.

21 Little children, guard yourselves from the idols. Amen.

2 John

Chapter 1

1 The elder to the chosen lady and her children, whom I love in truth, and not I alone, but also all who have known the truth,

2 because of the truth remaining in us, and it will be with us forever.

3 Grace, mercy, peace will be with us from God the Father and from the Lord Jesus Christ, the Son of the Father, in truth and love.

4 I rejoiced greatly because I have found some of your children walking in truth, as we received commandment from the Father.

5 And now I ask you, lady, not as writing a new commandment to you, but the one which we had from the beginning, that we should love one another.

6 And this is love, that we should walk according to his commandments. This is the commandment, as you heard from the beginning, that you should walk in it.

7 Because many deceivers entered into the world, those not confessing Jesus Christ coming in flesh. This is the deceiver and the antichrist.

8 Watch yourselves, so that we may not lose what we worked, but may receive a full reward.

9 Everyone transgressing and not remaining in the teaching of Christ does not have God; the one remaining in the teaching of Christ, this one has both the Father and the Son.

10 If anyone comes to you and does not bring this teaching, do not receive him into a house, and do not say greetings to him.

11 For the one saying greetings to him partakes of his evil works.

12 Having many things to write to you, I did not wish through paper and ink, but I hope to come to you and speak mouth to mouth, so that our joy may be fulfilled.

13 The children of your chosen sister greet you. Amen.

3 John

Chapter 1

1 The elder to the beloved Gaius, whom I love in truth.

2 Beloved, concerning all things I pray that you prosper and be healthy, as your soul prospers.

3 For I rejoiced greatly when brothers came and testified to your truth, as you walk in truth.

4 I have no greater joy than these things, that I hear my own children walking in truth.

5 Beloved, you do a faithful thing, whatever you work toward the brothers and toward the strangers,

6 who testified to your love before the church; whom you will do well to send onward worthily of God.

7 For on behalf of the name they went out, receiving nothing from the nations.

8 Therefore we ought to receive such ones, so that we may become fellow workers with the truth.

9 I wrote to the church, but Diotrephes, who loves to be first among them, does not receive us.

10 Because of this, if I come, I will bring to remembrance his works which he does, babbling against us with evil words; and not being content with these, neither does he himself receive the brothers, and he prevents those wishing to and casts them out of the church.

11 Beloved, do not imitate the evil but the good. The one doing good is from God, but the one doing evil has not seen God.

12 Demetrius has been testified to by all and by the truth itself; and we also testify, and you know that our testimony is true.

13 I had many things to write, but I do not wish to write to you through ink and reed.

14 But I hope to see you immediately, and we will speak mouth to mouth.

15 Peace to you. The friends greet you. Greet the friends by name.

Jude

Chapter 1

1 Jude, a slave of Jesus Christ, and brother of James, to the called, sanctified in God the Father and kept for Jesus Christ:

2 May mercy and peace and love be multiplied to you.

3 Beloved, making all diligence to write to you concerning the common salvation, I had necessity to write to you, urging you to contend earnestly for the faith once handed down to the saints.

4 For certain men slipped in, those long ago written beforehand for this judgment, ungodly, changing the grace of our God into licentiousness and denying the only master God and our Lord Jesus Christ.

5 But I wish to remind you, you knowing this once, that the Lord, having saved a people out of the land of Egypt, the second time destroyed those not believing.

6 And angels who did not keep their own rule but left their own dwelling, he has kept in everlasting bonds under gloom for judgment of a great day.

7 As Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them, having committed fornication in a manner like these and gone after other flesh, are set forth as an example, undergoing punishment of eternal fire.

8 Yet likewise these also, dreaming, indeed defile flesh, and set aside lordship, and blaspheme glories.

9 But Michael the archangel, when disputing with the devil he was arguing concerning the body of Moses, did not dare to bring a judgment of blasphemy, but said: May the Lord rebuke you.

10 But these blaspheme whatever they do not know, and whatever they understand naturally, like the irrational animals, in these things they are corrupted.

11 Woe to them, because they went in the way of Cain, and for reward poured themselves out in the wandering of Balaam, and perished in the opposition of Korah.

12 These are reefs in your love feasts, feasting together without fear, shepherding themselves; waterless clouds carried about by winds; autumn trees, fruitless, having died twice, uprooted;

13 wild waves of the sea foaming up their own shames; wandering stars, for whom the gloom of darkness has been kept forever.

14 And Enoch, seventh from Adam, also prophesied to these, saying: Behold, the Lord came with his holy myriads,

15 to do judgment against all, and convict all their ungodly ones concerning all their works of ungodliness which they did ungodly, and concerning all the hard things which ungodly sinners spoke against him.

16 These are murmurers, complainers, walking according to their desires, and their mouth speaks swollen things, admiring persons for the sake of benefit.

17 But you, beloved, remember the words spoken beforehand by the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ,

18 that they were saying to you that in the last time there will be mockers walking according to their own desires of ungodlinesses.

19 These are those making divisions, natural, not having the Spirit.

20 But you, beloved, building yourselves upon your most holy faith, praying in the Holy Spirit,

21 keep yourselves in the love of God, awaiting the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ unto eternal life.

22 And have mercy on some, making distinctions,

23 but save others with fear, snatching them from the fire, hating even the tunic stained by the flesh.

24 But to the one able to guard them without stumbling, and to stand them blameless before his glory in exultation,

25 to the only wise God our Savior, be glory and majesty, dominion and authority, both now and unto all the ages. Amen.

Revelation

Chapter 1

1 Revelation of Jesus Christ, which God gave him to show his slaves what must happen soon; and he signified it, sending through his angel to his slave John,

2 who testified to the word of God and the testimony of Jesus Christ, and whatever he saw.

3 Blessed is the one reading, and those hearing the words of the prophecy and keeping the things written in it, for the time is near.

4 John to the seven churches in Asia: Grace to you and peace from the one who is and who was and who is coming, and from the seven spirits which are before his throne,

5 and from Jesus Christ, the faithful witness, the firstborn from the dead and the ruler of the kings of the earth. To the one who loved us and washed us from our sins in his blood,

6 and made us kings and priests to his God and Father, to him be the glory and the dominion forever and ever. Amen.

7 Behold, he comes with the clouds, and every eye will see him, and those who pierced him, and all the tribes of the earth will mourn over him. Yes, amen.

8 I am the Alpha and the Omega, beginning and end, says the Lord, the one who is and who was and who is coming, the Almighty.

9 I, John, also your brother and fellow partaker in the affliction and in the kingdom and endurance of Jesus Christ, came to be on the island called Patmos because of the word of God and because of the testimony of Jesus Christ.

10 I came to be in the Spirit on the Lord's day, and heard behind me a great voice like a trumpet,

11 saying: I am the Alpha and the Omega, the first and the last; and what you see, write in a book and send to the churches in Asia, to Ephesus and to Smyrna and to Pergamum and to Thyatira and to Sardis and to Philadelphia and to Laodicea.

12 And I turned to see the voice which spoke with me, and having turned I saw seven golden lampstands,

13 and in the midst of the seven lampstands one like a son of man, clothed in a garment reaching to the feet and girded at the breasts with a golden belt.

14 And his head and hairs were white as white wool, as snow, and his eyes as a flame of fire,

15 and his feet like fine bronze, as having been fired in a furnace, and his voice as a voice of many waters,

16 and having in his right hand seven stars, and from his mouth a sharp two-edged sword going out, and his appearance as the sun shines in its power.

17 And when I saw him, I fell at his feet as dead; and he laid his right hand upon me, saying to me: Do not fear; I am the first and the last,

18 and the living one, and I became dead, and behold, I am living forever and ever. Amen. And I have the keys of Hades and of death.

19 Write what you saw, and what is, and what is about to happen after these things.

20 The mystery of the seven stars which you saw upon my right hand, and the seven golden lampstands: The seven stars are angels of the seven churches, and the seven lampstands which you saw are seven churches.

Chapter 2

1 To the angel of the Ephesian church write: These things says the one holding the seven stars in his right hand, the one walking in the midst of the seven golden lampstands:

2 I know your works and your labor and your endurance, and that you cannot bear evil ones; and you tested those claiming to be apostles and are not, and found them false.

3 And you bore, and have endurance, and because of my name you have labored and have not grown weary.

4 But I have against you that you left your first love.

5 Therefore remember from where you have fallen, and repent and do the first works; but if not, I come to you quickly and will move your lampstand from its place, unless you repent.

6 But this you have, that you hate the works of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate.

7 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches. To the one overcoming, I will give him to eat from the tree of life, which is in the midst of the paradise of God.

8 And to the angel of the church of the Smyrnaeans write: These things says the first and the last, who became dead and lived:

9 I know your works and affliction and poverty, but you are rich, and the blasphemy of those saying they themselves are Jews and are not, but a synagogue of Satan.

10 Fear none of the things you are about to suffer. Behold, the devil is about to cast some of you into prison, so that you may be tested, and you will have affliction for ten days. Become faithful until death, and I will give you the crown of life.

11 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches. The one overcoming will certainly not be harmed by the second death.

12 And to the angel of the church in Pergamum write: These things says the one having the sharp two-edged sword:

13 I know your works and where you dwell, where the throne of Satan is; and you hold my name and did not deny my faith, even in the days in which Antipas, my faithful witness, was killed among you, where Satan dwells.

14 But I have a few things against you, because you have there those holding the teaching of Balaam, who was teaching Balak to put a stumbling block before the sons of Israel, to eat things sacrificed to idols and commit fornication.

15 Thus you also have those holding the teaching of the Nicolaitans, which I hate.

16 Repent; but if not, I come to you quickly and will wage war with them by the sword of my mouth.

17 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches. To the one overcoming, I will give him to eat from the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, and upon the stone a new name written, which no one knew except the one receiving.

18 And to the angel of the church in Thyatira write: These things says the Son of God, the one having his eyes as a flame of fire, and his feet like fine bronze:

19 I know your works and love and ministry and faith and your endurance, and your works, and the last more than the first.

20 But I have a few things against you, because you allow the woman Jezebel, who calls herself a prophetess, to teach, and my slaves to be deceived to commit fornication and eat things sacrificed to idols.

21 And I gave her time so that she might repent from her fornication, and she did not repent.

22 Behold, I cast her into a bed, and those committing adultery with her into great affliction, unless they repent from their works.

23 And her children I will kill with death, and all the churches will know that I am the one searching kidneys and hearts; and I will give to you, each, according to your works.

24 But to you I say, and to the rest in Thyatira, as many as do not have this teaching, and who did not know the depths of Satan, as they say: I will not put upon you another burden.

25 Only hold what you have until I come.

26 And the one overcoming and keeping my works until the end, I will give him authority over the nations,

27 and he will shepherd them with an iron rod; as the pottery vessels are shattered, as I also have received from my Father.

28 And I will give him the morning star.

29 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches.

Chapter 3

1 And to the angel of the church in Sardis write: These things says the one having the spirits of God and the seven stars: I know your works, that you have the name that you live, and you are dead.

2 Become watchful, and establish the remaining things which are about to die, for I have not found your works fulfilled before God.

3 Therefore remember how you have received and heard, and keep and repent. Therefore if you do not keep watch, I will come upon you as a thief, and you will certainly not know at what hour I will come upon you.

4 You have a few names even in Sardis which did not defile their garments, and they will walk with me in white, because they are worthy.

5 The one overcoming, this one will be clothed in white garments, and I will certainly not erase his name from the book of life, and I will confess his name before my Father and before his angels.

6 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches.

7 And to the angel of the church in Philadelphia write: These things says the holy one, the true one, the one having the key of David, the one opening and no one shuts, and shuts and no one opens:

8 I know your works. Behold, I have given before you an opened door, and no one can shut it, because you have a little power, and kept my word and did not deny my name.

9 Behold, I give from the synagogue of Satan, those saying they themselves are Jews and are not, but lie; behold, I will make them come and bow before your feet and know that I loved you.

10 Because you kept the word of my endurance, I also will keep you from the hour of trial about to come upon the whole inhabited world, to test those dwelling upon the earth.

11 Behold, I come quickly. Hold what you have, so that no one may take your crown.

12 The one overcoming, I will make him a pillar in the temple of my God, and he will certainly not go out anymore; and I will write upon him the name of my God and the name of the city of my God, the new Jerusalem, which comes down out of heaven from my God, and my new name.

13 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches.

14 And to the angel of the church of the Laodiceans write: These things says the Amen, the faithful and true witness, the beginning of the creation of God:

15 I know your works, that you are neither cold nor hot. Would that you were cold or hot!

16 Thus, because you are lukewarm and neither cold nor hot, I am about to vomit you from my mouth.

17 Because you say: I am rich and have become wealthy and have need of nothing, and do not know that you are the miserable and pitiable and poor and blind and naked one,

18 I counsel you to buy from me gold refined by fire, so that you may be rich, and white garments, so that you may clothe yourself and the shame of your nakedness may not be manifested; and anoint your eyes with eye salve, so that you may see.

19 As many as I love, I reprove and discipline; therefore be zealous and repent.

20 Behold, I have stood at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will enter to him and dine with him, and he with me.

21 The one overcoming, I will give him to sit with me on my throne, as I also overcame and sat with my Father on his throne.

22 The one having an ear, let him hear what the Spirit says to the churches.

Chapter 4

1 After these things I saw, and behold, a door opened in heaven, and the first voice which I heard, as of a trumpet speaking with me, saying: Come up here, and I will show you what must happen after these things.

2 And immediately I came to be in the Spirit, and behold, a throne was set in heaven, and upon the throne one sitting.

3 And the one sitting was like in appearance to a jasper and sardine stone, and a rainbow around the throne like in appearance to emerald.

4 And around the throne were twenty-four thrones, and upon the thrones I saw the twenty-four elders sitting, clothed in white garments, and they had upon their heads golden crowns.

5 And from the throne go out lightnings and thunders and voices, and seven lamps of fire burning before the throne, which are the seven spirits of God.

6 And before the throne a glassy sea like crystal, and in the midst of the throne and around the throne four living creatures full of eyes in front and behind.

7 And the first living creature like a lion, and the second living creature like a calf, and the third living creature having the face as a man, and the fourth living creature like a flying eagle.

8 And the four living creatures, each one by itself, had six wings apiece, around and within full of eyes; and they have no rest day and night, saying: Holy, holy, holy, Lord God Almighty, who was and who is and who is coming.

9 And whenever the living creatures will give glory and honor and thanksgiving to the one sitting upon the throne, the one living forever and ever,

10 the twenty-four elders will fall before the one sitting upon the throne, and worship the one living forever and ever, and cast their crowns before the throne, saying:

11 You are worthy, Lord, to receive the glory and the honor and the power, because you created all things, and because of your will they are and were created.

Chapter 5

1 And I saw upon the right hand of the one sitting upon the throne a book written within and behind, sealed with seven seals.

2 And I saw a strong angel proclaiming with a great voice: Who is worthy to open the book and loose its seals?

3 And no one in heaven nor upon the earth nor beneath the earth was able to open the book nor look at it.

4 And I wept much because no one was found worthy to open and read the book, nor look at it.

5 And one of the elders says to me: Do not weep; behold, the lion from the tribe of Judah, the root of David, overcame, to open the book and loose its seven seals.

6 And I saw, and behold, in the midst of the throne and of the four living creatures and in the midst of the elders, a lamb standing as slaughtered, having seven horns and seven eyes, which are the seven spirits of God sent into all the earth.

7 And he came and has taken the book from the right hand of the one sitting upon the throne.

8 And when he took the book, the four living creatures and the twenty-four elders fell before the lamb, each having harps and golden bowls full of incenses, which are the prayers of the saints.

9 And they sing a new song, saying: You are worthy to take the book and open its seals, because you were slaughtered and bought us for God in your blood from every tribe and tongue and people and nation,

10 and made us kings and priests to our God, and we will reign upon the earth.

11 And I saw and heard a voice of many angels around the throne and the living creatures and the elders, and thousands of thousands,

12 saying with a great voice: Worthy is the lamb who has been slaughtered to receive the power and wealth and wisdom and strength and honor and glory and blessing.

13 And every creature which is in heaven and on the earth and beneath the earth and upon the sea, the things which are, and all the things in them, I heard saying: To the one sitting upon the throne and to the lamb, the blessing and the honor and the glory and the dominion forever and ever.

14 And the four living creatures were saying: Amen. And the twenty-four elders fell and worshiped the one living forever and ever.

Chapter 6

1 And I saw when the lamb opened one of the seals, and heard one of the four living creatures saying as a voice of thunder: Come and see.

2 And I saw, and behold, a white horse, and the one sitting upon it having a bow; and a crown was given him, and he went out overcoming and so that he might overcome.

3 And when he opened the second seal, I heard the second living creature saying: Come and see.

4 And another horse went out, fiery red, and to the one sitting upon it was given to take peace from the earth, and so that they might slaughter one another; and a great sword was given him.

5 And when he opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature saying: Come and see. And I saw, and behold, a black horse, and the one sitting upon it having a balance in his hand.

6 And I heard a voice in the midst of the four living creatures saying: A choenix of wheat for a denarius, and three choenixes of barley for a denarius; and do not harm the oil and the wine.

7 And when he opened the fourth seal, I heard the voice of the fourth living creature saying: Come and see.

8 And I saw, and behold, a pale green horse, and the one sitting upon it, his name Death, and Hades follows with him; and authority was given them to kill over the fourth of the earth with sword and with famine and with death and by the beasts of the earth.

9 And when he opened the fifth seal, I saw beneath the altar the souls of those slaughtered because of the word of God and because of the testimony which they had.

10 And they were crying with a great voice, saying: Until when, holy and true master, do you not judge and avenge our blood upon those dwelling on the earth?

11 And white robes were given to each, and it was said to them that they should rest yet a little time, until both their fellow slaves and their brothers, those about to be killed as they also were, should be fulfilled.

12 And I saw when he opened the sixth seal, and behold, a great earthquake occurred, and the sun became black as a sack of hair, and the moon became as blood,

13 and the stars of heaven fell to the earth, as a fig tree casts its unripe figs when shaken by a great wind.

14 And heaven was separated as a book being rolled up, and every mountain and island were moved from their places.

15 And the kings of the earth and the great ones and the rich and the commanders of thousands and the powerful and every slave and every free one hid themselves in the caves and in the rocks of the mountains,

16 and say to the mountains and the rocks: Fall upon us and hide us from the face of the one sitting upon the throne and from the wrath of the lamb,

17 because the great day of his wrath came, and who is able to stand?

Chapter 7

1 And after these things I saw four angels standing upon the four corners of the earth, holding the four winds of the earth, so that wind might not blow upon the earth nor upon the sea nor upon any tree.

2 And I saw another angel coming up from the rising of the sun, having a seal of the living God, and he cried with a great voice to the four angels to whom it was given to harm the earth and the sea,

3 saying: Do not harm the earth nor the sea nor the trees, until we seal the slaves of our God upon their foreheads.

4 And I heard the number of those sealed: a hundred forty-four thousand sealed from every tribe of the sons of Israel.

5 From the tribe of Judah twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Reuben twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Gad twelve thousand sealed;

6 from the tribe of Asher twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Naphtali twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Manasseh twelve thousand sealed;

7 from the tribe of Simeon twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Levi twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Issachar twelve thousand sealed;

8 from the tribe of Zebulun twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Joseph twelve thousand sealed; from the tribe of Benjamin twelve thousand sealed.

9 After these things I saw, and behold, a great crowd which no one was able to number, from every nation and tribes and peoples and tongues, standing before the throne and before the lamb, clothed in white robes, and palms in their hands,

10 and crying with a great voice, saying: Salvation to the one sitting upon the throne of our God, and to the lamb.

11 And all the angels had stood around the throne and the elders and the four living creatures, and fell before the throne upon their face and worshiped God,

12 saying: Amen. The blessing and the glory and the wisdom and the thanksgiving and the honor and the power and the strength to our God forever and ever. Amen.

13 And one of the elders answered, saying to me: These clothed in the white robes, who are they, and from where did they come?

14 And I have said to him: Lord, you know. And he said to me: These are those coming out of the great affliction, and they washed their robes and whitened their robes in the blood of the lamb.

15 Because of this they are before the throne of God, and serve him day and night in his temple, and the one sitting upon the throne will dwell in a tent over them.

16 They will hunger no more, nor thirst anymore, nor will the sun fall upon them, nor any heat,

17 because the lamb in the midst of the throne will shepherd them and guide them to living springs of waters, and God will wipe away every tear from their eyes.

Chapter 8

1 And when he opened the seventh seal, there was silence in heaven for about half an hour.

2 And I saw the seven angels who stand before God, and seven trumpets were given them.

3 And another angel came and stood upon the altar, having a golden censer; and much incense was given him, so that he might give it to the prayers of all the saints upon the golden altar before the throne.

4 And the smoke of the incense went up with the prayers of the saints from the hand of the angel before God.

5 And the angel has taken the censer and filled it from the fire of the altar and cast it to the earth, and there were voices and thunders and lightnings and an earthquake.

6 And the seven angels having the seven trumpets prepared themselves so that they might trumpet.

7 And the first angel trumpeted, and there came hail and fire mingled with blood, and it was cast to the earth, and the third of the trees was burned up, and all green grass was burned up.

8 And the second angel trumpeted, and as a great mountain burning with fire was cast into the sea, and the third of the sea became blood,

9 and the third of the creatures in the sea, those having souls, died, and the third of the ships was destroyed.

10 And the third angel trumpeted, and a great star fell from heaven, burning as a lamp, and it fell upon the third of the rivers and upon the springs of waters.

11 And the name of the star is called Wormwood; and the third becomes wormwood, and many of men died from the waters, because they were made bitter.

12 And the fourth angel trumpeted, and the third of the sun was struck, and the third of the moon and the third of the stars, so that the third of them might be darkened, and the day might not shine for the third of it, and the night likewise.

13 And I saw and heard one angel flying in midheaven, saying with a great voice: Woe, woe, woe to those dwelling upon the earth, from the remaining voices of the trumpet of the three angels about to trumpet.

Chapter 9

1 And the fifth angel trumpeted, and I saw a star having fallen from heaven to the earth, and the key of the shaft of the abyss was given him.

2 And he opened the shaft of the abyss, and smoke went up from the shaft as smoke of a great furnace, and the sun and the air were darkened from the smoke of the shaft.

3 And from the smoke locusts came out to the earth, and authority was given them as the scorpions of the earth have authority.

4 And it was said to them that they should not harm the grass of the earth nor any green thing nor any tree, except only the men who do not have the seal of God upon their foreheads.

5 And it was given them that they should not kill them, but that they should be tormented for five months; and their torment as a scorpion's torment when it strikes a man.

6 And in those days men will seek death and will not find it, and will desire to die, and death will flee from them.

7 And the likenesses of the locusts were like horses prepared for war, and upon their heads as crowns like gold, and their faces as faces of men.

8 And they had hairs as hairs of women, and their teeth were as those of lions.

9 And they had breastplates as iron breastplates, and the sound of their wings as a sound of chariots of many horses running into war.

10 And they have tails like scorpions, and stings were in their tails, and their authority to harm men for five months.

11 And they have over them as king the angel of the abyss; his name in Hebrew Abaddon, and in Greek he has the name Apollyon.

12 The one woe passed; behold, two woes still come after these things.

13 And the sixth angel trumpeted, and I heard one voice from the four horns of the golden altar before God,

14 saying to the sixth angel who had the trumpet: Loose the four angels bound at the great river Euphrates.

15 And the four angels were loosed, those prepared for the hour and day and month and year, so that they might kill the third of men.

16 And the number of armies of the cavalry was two myriads of myriads, and I heard their number.

17 And thus I saw the horses in the vision and those sitting upon them, having fiery and hyacinth-colored and sulfurous breastplates; and the heads of the horses as heads of lions, and from their mouths go out fire and smoke and sulfur.

18 By these three the third of men were killed, from the fire and from the smoke and from the sulfur going out from their mouths.

19 For their authorities are in their mouth, for their tails are like serpents, having heads, and with them they harm.

20 And the rest of men, who were not killed in these plagues, did not even repent from the works of their hands, so as not to worship the demons and the idols, the golden and the silver and the bronze and the stone and the wooden, which can neither see nor hear nor walk.

21 And they did not repent from their murders nor from their sorceries nor from their fornication nor from their thefts.

Chapter 10

1 And I saw another strong angel coming down from heaven, clothed with a cloud, and a rainbow upon the head, and his face as the sun, and his feet as pillars of fire.

2 And he had in his hand an opened little book, and placed his right foot upon the sea and the left upon the earth,

3 and cried with a great voice, as a lion roars; and when he cried, the seven thunders spoke their own voices.

4 And when the seven thunders spoke their own voices, I was about to write; and I heard a voice from heaven saying to me: Seal what the seven thunders spoke, and do not write these things.

5 And the angel whom I saw standing upon the sea and upon the earth raised his hand into heaven,

6 and swore by the one living forever and ever, who created heaven and the things in it and the earth and the things in it and the sea and the things in it, that there will be time no more,

7 but in the days of the voice of the seventh angel, when he is about to trumpet, the mystery of God should also be completed, as he proclaimed the good news to his own slaves, the prophets.

8 And the voice which I heard from heaven again speaking with me and saying: Go, take the opened little book in the hand of the angel standing upon the sea and upon the earth.

9 And I went to the angel, saying to him: Give me the little book. And he says to me: Take and eat it up, and it will make your belly bitter, but in your mouth it will be sweet as honey.

10 And I took the little book from the hand of the angel and ate it up, and in my mouth it was sweet as honey; and when I ate it, my belly was made bitter.

11 And he says to me: You must prophesy again concerning peoples and nations and tongues and many kings.

Chapter 11

1 And a reed like a rod was given me, saying: Rise and measure the temple of God and the altar and those worshiping in it.

2 And the court within the temple, cast outside and do not measure it, because it was given to the nations, and they will tread the holy city for forty-two months.

3 And I will give to my two witnesses, and they will prophesy for a thousand two hundred sixty days, clothed in sacks.

4 These are the two olive trees and two lampstands standing before the God of the earth.

5 And if anyone wishes to harm them, fire goes out from their mouth and devours their enemies; and if anyone wishes to harm them, thus he must be killed.

6 These have authority to shut heaven, so that rain may not fall in the days of their prophecy; and they have authority over the waters to turn them into blood, and to strike the earth with every plague as often as they wish.

7 And when they complete their testimony, the beast coming up from the abyss will make war with them and overcome them and kill them.

8 And their corpses upon the street of the great city, which is called spiritually Sodom and Egypt, where also our Lord was crucified.

9 And those from the peoples and tribes and tongues and nations will look at their corpses for three and a half days, and will not allow their corpses to be placed in tombs.

10 And those dwelling upon the earth will rejoice over them and be glad, and will send gifts to one another, because these two prophets tormented those dwelling upon the earth.

11 And after the three and a half days a spirit of life from God entered upon them, and they stood upon their feet, and great fear fell upon those observing them.

12 And they heard a great voice from heaven saying to them: Come up here. And they went up into heaven in the cloud, and their enemies observed them.

13 And in that hour there was a great earthquake, and the tenth of the city fell, and in the earthquake seven thousand names of men were killed, and the rest became fearful and gave glory to the God of heaven.

14 The second woe passed; behold, the third woe comes quickly.

15 And the seventh angel trumpeted, and there were great voices in heaven, saying: The kingdoms of the world became those of our Lord and of his Christ, and he will reign forever and ever.

16 And the twenty-four elders sitting before God upon their thrones fell upon their faces and worshiped God,

17 saying: We thank you, Lord God Almighty, who is and who was and who is coming, because you have taken your great power and reigned.

18 And the nations were enraged, and your wrath came, and the time of the dead to be judged, and to give the reward to your slaves the prophets and to the saints and to those fearing your name, the small and the great, and to destroy those destroying the earth.

19 And the temple of God in heaven was opened, and the ark of his covenant was seen in his temple, and there were lightnings and voices and thunders and an earthquake and great hail.

Chapter 12

1 And a great sign was seen in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon beneath her feet, and upon her head a crown of twelve stars.

2 And having in the womb, she cries, suffering birth pains and being tormented to give birth.

3 And another sign was seen in heaven, and behold, a great fiery red dragon having seven heads and ten horns, and upon his heads seven diadems.

4 And his tail drags the third of the stars of heaven and cast them to the earth; and the dragon has stood before the woman about to give birth, so that when she gives birth he may devour her child.

5 And she gave birth to a male son, who is about to shepherd all the nations with an iron rod; and her child was snatched to God and his throne.

6 And the woman fled into the wilderness, where she has a place prepared by God, so that there they may nourish her for a thousand two hundred sixty days.

7 And there was war in heaven: Michael and his angels fought against the dragon, and the dragon fought, and his angels,

8 and they did not prevail, nor was their place found anymore in heaven.

9 And the great dragon was cast out, the ancient serpent, the one called Devil and Satan, who deceives the whole inhabited world; he was cast to the earth, and his angels were cast with him.

10 And I heard a great voice saying in heaven: Now came the salvation and the power and the kingdom of our God and the authority of his Christ, because the accuser of our brothers was cast down, the one accusing them before our God day and night.

11 And they overcame him because of the blood of the lamb and because of the word of their testimony, and they did not love their soul until death.

12 Because of this rejoice, heavens and those dwelling in tents in them. Woe to those dwelling on the earth and the sea, because the devil came down to you, having great wrath, knowing that he has a little time.

13 And when the dragon saw that he was cast to the earth, he pursued the woman who gave birth to the male.

14 And the two wings of the great eagle were given to the woman, so that she may fly into the wilderness, into her place, where she is nourished there for a time and times and half a time, away from the face of the serpent.

15 And the serpent cast from his mouth after the woman water as a river, so that he might make her carried away by the river.

16 And the earth helped the woman, and the earth opened its mouth and swallowed the river which the dragon cast from his mouth.

17 And the dragon was enraged at the woman, and went away to make war with the rest of her seed, those keeping the commandments of God and having the testimony of Jesus Christ.

18 And I stood upon the sand of the sea.

Chapter 13

1 And I saw a beast coming up from the sea, having seven heads and ten horns, and upon its horns ten diadems, and upon its heads a name of blasphemy.

2 And the beast which I saw was like a leopard, and its feet as those of a bear, and its mouth as a mouth of a lion; and the dragon gave it his power and his throne and great authority.

3 And I saw one of its heads as slaughtered to death, and its wound of death was healed, and there was wonder in all the earth after the beast.

4 And they worshiped the dragon who gave authority to the beast, and worshiped the beast, saying: Who is like the beast? Who can make war with it?

5 And a mouth speaking great things and blasphemies was given it, and authority to act for forty-two months was given it.

6 And it opened its mouth for blasphemy toward God, to blaspheme his name and his tent and those dwelling in tents in heaven.

7 And it was given it to make war with the saints and overcome them, and authority was given it over every tribe and tongue and nation.

8 And all those dwelling upon the earth will worship it, whose names have not been written in the book of life of the lamb slaughtered from the foundation of the world.

9 If anyone has an ear, let him hear.

10 If anyone gathers captivity, he goes into captivity; if anyone will kill with a sword, he must be killed with a sword. Here is the endurance and the faith of the saints.

11 And I saw another beast coming up from the earth, and it had two horns like a lamb, and was speaking as a dragon.

12 And it exercises all the authority of the first beast before it, and makes the earth and those dwelling in it worship the first beast, whose wound of death was healed.

13 And it does great signs, so that it even makes fire come down from heaven to the earth before men.

14 And it deceives those dwelling upon the earth because of the signs which it was given it to do before the beast, saying to those dwelling upon the earth to make an image to the beast which has the wound of the sword and lived.

15 And it was given it to give spirit to the image of the beast, so that the image of the beast might even speak and make as many as do not worship the image of the beast be killed.

16 And it makes all, the small and the great and the rich and the poor and the free and the slaves, so that it may give them a mark upon their right hand or upon their foreheads,

17 and so that no one may be able to buy or sell except the one having the mark or the name of the beast or the number of its name.

18 Here is wisdom. The one having understanding, let him calculate the number of the beast, for it is a number of a man, and its number is six hundred sixty-six.

Chapter 14

1 And I saw, and behold, a lamb standing upon Mount Zion, and with him a hundred forty-four thousand having the name of his Father written upon their foreheads.

2 And I heard a voice from heaven as a voice of many waters and as a voice of great thunder, and I heard a voice of harpists playing on their harps.

3 And they sing as a new song before the throne and before the four living creatures and the elders; and no one was able to learn the song except the hundred forty-four thousand, those bought from the earth.

4 These are those who were not defiled with women, for they are virgins. These are those following the lamb wherever he goes. These were bought from men, a firstfruits to God and to the lamb.

5 And in their mouth deceit was not found, for they are without blemish before the throne of God.

6 And I saw another angel flying in midheaven, having eternal good news to proclaim to those dwelling upon the earth, and every nation and tribe and tongue and people,

7 saying with a great voice: Fear God and give him glory, because the hour of his judgment came; and worship the one who made heaven and earth and sea and springs of waters.

8 And another angel followed, saying: Fell, fell Babylon, the great city, because she has made all nations drink from the wine of the wrath of her fornication.

9 And a third angel followed them, saying with a great voice: If anyone worships the beast and its image and receives a mark upon his forehead or upon his hand,

10 he also will drink from the wine of the wrath of God, mixed unmixed in the cup of his anger, and will be tormented with fire and sulfur before the holy angels and before the lamb.

11 And the smoke of their torment goes up forever and ever, and they have no rest day and night, those worshiping the beast and its image, and if anyone receives the mark of its name.

12 Here is endurance of the saints; here are those keeping the commandments of God and the faith of Jesus.

13 And I heard a voice from heaven saying to me: Write: Blessed are the dead who die in the Lord from now on. Yes, says the Spirit, so that they may rest from their labors, and their works follow with them.

14 And I saw, and behold, a white cloud, and upon the cloud one sitting like a son of man, having upon his head a golden crown and in his hand a sharp sickle.

15 And another angel came out of the temple, crying with a great voice to the one sitting upon the cloud: Send your sickle and reap, because the hour to reap came for you, because the harvest of the earth has dried.

16 And the one sitting upon the cloud cast his sickle upon the earth, and the earth was reaped.

17 And another angel came out of the temple in heaven, himself also having a sharp sickle.

18 And another angel came out of the altar, having authority over the fire, and called with a great cry to the one having the sharp sickle, saying: Send your sharp sickle and gather the clusters of the earth, because its grapes have ripened.

19 And the angel cast his sickle into the earth and gathered the vine of the earth, and cast into the great winepress of the wrath of God.

20 And the winepress was trodden outside the city, and blood came out of the winepress as far as the bridles of the horses, for a thousand six hundred stadia.

Chapter 15

1 And I saw another sign in heaven, great and marvelous, seven angels having seven plagues, the last, because in them the wrath of God was completed.

2 And I saw as a glassy sea mingled with fire, and those overcoming the beast and its image and its mark, the number of its name, standing upon the glassy sea, having harps of God.

3 And they sing the song of Moses, slave of God, and the song of the lamb, saying: Great and marvelous are your works, Lord God Almighty; righteous and true are your ways, king of the saints.

4 Who will certainly not fear you, Lord, and glorify your name? Because you alone are holy; because all the nations will come and worship before you, because your righteous ordinances were manifested.

5 And after these things I saw, and behold, the temple of the tent of testimony in heaven was opened,

6 and the seven angels having the seven plagues came out of the temple, clothed in pure and splendid linen and girded around the breasts with golden belts.

7 And one of the four living creatures gave the seven angels seven golden bowls full of the wrath of God, the one living forever and ever.

8 And the temple was filled with smoke from the glory of God and from his power, and no one was able to enter the temple until the seven plagues of the seven angels should be completed.

Chapter 16

1 And I heard a great voice from the temple saying to the seven angels: Go and pour out the bowls of the wrath of God into the earth.

2 And the first went away and poured out his bowl upon the earth, and there came a bad and evil sore upon the men having the mark of the beast and those worshiping its image.

3 And the second angel poured out his bowl into the sea, and it became blood as of a dead one, and every living soul died in the sea.

4 And the third angel poured out his bowl into the rivers and into the springs of the waters, and it became blood.

5 And I heard the angel of the waters saying: You are righteous, Lord, the one who is and who was and the holy one, because you judged these things,

6 because they poured out blood of saints and prophets, and you gave them blood to drink, for they are worthy.

7 And I heard another from the altar saying: Yes, Lord God Almighty, true and righteous are your judgments.

8 And the fourth angel poured out his bowl upon the sun, and it was given him to scorch men with fire.

9 And men were scorched with great heat, and blasphemed the name of God, the one having authority over these plagues, and did not repent to give him glory.

10 And the fifth angel poured out his bowl upon the throne of the beast, and its kingdom became darkened, and they were chewing their tongues from the pain,

11 and blasphemed the God of heaven from their pains and from their sores, and did not repent from their works.

12 And the sixth angel poured out his bowl upon the great river Euphrates, and its water was dried, so that the way of the kings from the risings of the sun might be prepared.

13 And I saw from the mouth of the dragon and from the mouth of the beast and from the mouth of the false prophet three unclean spirits like frogs.

14 For they are spirits of demons doing signs, to go out to the kings of the earth and of the whole inhabited world, to gather them to war of that great day of God Almighty.

15 Behold, I come as a thief. Blessed is the one watching and keeping his garments, so that he may not walk naked and they see his shame.

16 And he gathered them into the place called in Hebrew Armageddon.

17 And the seventh angel poured out his bowl into the air, and a great voice came out from the temple of heaven, from the throne, saying: It has happened.

18 And there were voices and thunders and lightnings, and there was a great earthquake, such as had not occurred since men came to be upon the earth, so great an earthquake, so mighty.

19 And the great city became three parts, and the cities of the nations fell, and Babylon the great was remembered before God, to give her the cup of the wine of the wrath of his anger.

20 And every island fled, and mountains were not found.

21 And great hail, as of a talent's weight, comes down from heaven upon men, and men blasphemed God from the plague of the hail, because its plague is exceedingly great.

Chapter 17

1 And one of the seven angels having the seven bowls came and spoke with me, saying to me: Come, I will show you the judgment of the great prostitute sitting upon the many waters,

2 with whom the kings of the earth committed fornication, and those dwelling on the earth were made drunk from the wine of her fornication.

3 And he carried me away into a wilderness in the Spirit, and I saw a woman sitting upon a scarlet beast full of names of blasphemy, having seven heads and ten horns.

4 And the woman was clothed with purple and scarlet, and gilded with gold and precious stone and pearls, having a golden cup in her hand full of abominations and uncleanness of her fornication,

5 and upon her forehead a name written: Mystery, Babylon the great, the mother of the prostitutes and of the abominations of the earth.

6 And I saw the woman drunk from the blood of the saints and from the blood of the witnesses of Jesus, and seeing her I marveled with great wonder.

7 And the angel said to me: Why did you marvel? I will tell you the mystery of the woman and of the beast bearing her, the one having the seven heads and the ten horns.

8 The beast which you saw was and is not, and is about to come up from the abyss and go into destruction; and those dwelling upon the earth will marvel, whose names have not been written upon the book of life from the foundation of the world, seeing the beast, that it was and is not, although it is.

9 Here is the understanding having wisdom: the seven heads are seven mountains, where the woman sits upon them.

10 And they are seven kings; the five fell, and the one is, the other has not yet come; and when he comes, he must remain a little.

11 And the beast which was and is not, he himself also is an eighth, and is from the seven, and goes into destruction.

12 And the ten horns which you saw are ten kings, who have not yet received a kingdom, but receive authority as kings for one hour with the beast.

13 These have one purpose, and will give their own power and authority to the beast.

14 These will make war with the lamb, and the lamb will overcome them, because he is Lord of lords and King of kings; and those with him are called and chosen and faithful.

15 And he says to me: The waters which you saw, where the prostitute sits, are peoples and crowds and nations and tongues.

16 And the ten horns which you saw upon the beast, these will hate the prostitute, and will make her desolated and naked, and will eat her flesh and burn her up with fire.

17 For God gave into their hearts to do his purpose, and to do one purpose, and to give their kingdom to the beast, until the words of God should be completed.

18 And the woman whom you saw is the great city having kingship over the kings of the earth.

Chapter 18

1 And after these things I saw an angel coming down from heaven, having great authority, and the earth was illuminated from his glory.

2 And he cried in strength with a great voice, saying: Fell, fell Babylon the great, and became a dwelling of demons and a prison of every unclean spirit and a prison of every unclean and hated bird,

3 because all the nations have drunk from the wine of the wrath of her fornication, and the kings of the earth committed fornication with her, and the merchants of the earth became rich from the power of her luxury.

4 And I heard another voice from heaven saying: Come out of her, my people, so that you may not partake together of her sins, and so that you may not receive from her plagues,

5 because her sins followed as far as heaven, and God remembered her wrongdoings.

6 Give back to her as she also gave back to you, and double to her double according to her works; in the cup which she mixed, mix double for her.

7 As much as she glorified herself and lived luxuriously, so much give her torment and mourning, because in her heart she says: I sit as a queen, and I am not a widow, and I will certainly not see mourning.

8 Because of this in one day her plagues will come, death and mourning and famine, and she will be burned up with fire, because strong is the Lord God judging her.

9 And the kings of the earth who committed fornication and lived luxuriously with her will weep for her and mourn over her, when they see the smoke of her burning,

10 standing from afar because of the fear of her torment, saying: Woe, woe, the great city Babylon, the strong city, because in one hour your judgment came.

11 And the merchants of the earth weep and mourn over her, because no one buys their cargo anymore,

12 cargo of gold and silver and precious stone and pearl and fine linen and purple and silk and scarlet, and every thyine wood and every ivory vessel and every vessel from most precious wood and bronze and iron and marble,

13 and cinnamon and incenses and ointment and frankincense and wine and oil and fine flour and wheat and cattle and sheep, and of horses and carriages and bodies, and souls of men.

14 And the ripe fruit of the desire of your soul departed from you, and all the rich and splendid things departed from you, and you will certainly not find them anymore.

15 The merchants of these things, those who became rich from her, will stand from afar because of the fear of her torment, weeping and mourning,

16 and saying: Woe, woe, the great city clothed with fine linen and purple and scarlet, and gilded with gold and precious stone and pearls,

17 because in one hour so great wealth was desolated. And every helmsman and all the company upon the ships and sailors and as many as work the sea stood from afar,

18 and were crying, seeing the smoke of her burning, saying: Who is like the great city?

19 And they cast dust upon their heads and were crying, weeping and mourning, saying: Woe, woe, the great city, in which all having ships in the sea became rich from her costliness, because in one hour she was desolated.

20 Rejoice over her, heaven and the holy apostles and the prophets, because God judged your judgment against her.

21 And one strong angel lifted a stone like a great millstone and cast it into the sea, saying: Thus with a rush Babylon the great city will be cast, and will certainly not be found anymore.

22 And a sound of harpists and musicians and flute players and trumpeters will certainly not be heard in you anymore; and any craftsman of any craft will certainly not be found in you anymore, and a sound of a mill will certainly not be heard in you anymore.

23 And a light of a lamp will certainly not shine in you anymore, and a voice of bridegroom and bride will certainly not be heard in you anymore, because your merchants were the great ones of the earth, because by your sorcery all the nations were deceived.

24 And in her was found blood of prophets and saints and of all those slaughtered upon the earth.

Chapter 19

1 And after these things I heard a great voice of a great crowd in heaven saying: Hallelujah, the salvation and the glory and the honor and the power to the Lord our God,

2 because true and righteous are his judgments, because he judged the great prostitute who corrupted the earth in her fornication, and avenged the blood of his slaves from her hand.

3 And a second time they have said: Hallelujah. And her smoke goes up forever and ever.

4 And the twenty-four elders and the four living creatures fell and worshiped God, the one sitting upon the throne, saying: Amen, hallelujah.

5 And a voice came out from the throne, saying: Praise our God, all his slaves and those fearing him, both the small and the great.

6 And I heard as a voice of a great crowd and as a voice of many waters and as a voice of strong thunders, saying: Hallelujah, because the Lord God Almighty reigned.

7 Let us rejoice and exult and give him the glory, because the marriage of the lamb came, and his wife prepared herself.

8 And it was given her that she might clothe herself with pure and splendid fine linen, for the fine linen is the righteous deeds of the saints.

9 And he says to me: Write: Blessed are those called to the supper of the marriage of the lamb. And he says to me: These are the true words of God.

10 And I fell before his feet to worship him, and he says to me: See that you do not; I am your fellow slave and of your brothers having the testimony of Jesus. Worship God. For the testimony of Jesus is the spirit of prophecy.

11 And I saw heaven opened, and behold, a white horse, and the one sitting upon it called Faithful and True, and in righteousness he judges and makes war.

12 And his eyes as a flame of fire, and upon his head many diadems, having a name written which no one knows except himself,

13 and clothed in a garment dipped in blood, and his name is called the Word of God.

14 And the armies in heaven were following him upon white horses, clothed in white and pure fine linen.

15 And from his mouth goes out a sharp sword, so that with it he may strike the nations; and he himself will shepherd them with an iron rod, and he himself treads the winepress of the wine of the wrath and of the anger of God Almighty.

16 And he has upon the garment and upon his thigh the name written: King of kings and Lord of lords.

17 And I saw one angel standing in the sun, and he cried with a great voice, saying to all the birds flying in midheaven: Come and gather to the supper of the great God,

18 so that you may eat flesh of kings and flesh of commanders of thousands and flesh of strong ones and flesh of horses and of those sitting upon them, and flesh of all, free and slaves and small and great.

19 And I saw the beast and the kings of the earth and their armies gathered to make war with the one sitting upon the horse and with his army.

20 And the beast was seized, and with it the false prophet who did the signs before it, by which he deceived those receiving the mark of the beast and those worshiping its image; the two were cast living into the lake of fire burning with sulfur.

21 And the rest were killed with the sword of the one sitting upon the horse, the one going out from his mouth, and all the birds were filled from their flesh.

Chapter 20

1 And I saw an angel coming down from heaven, having the key of the abyss and a great chain upon his hand.

2 And he seized the dragon, the ancient serpent, who is Devil and Satan, and bound him for a thousand years,

3 and cast him into the abyss and shut him in and sealed over him, so that he might not deceive the nations anymore until the thousand years should be completed; and after these things he must be loosed for a little time.

4 And I saw thrones, and they sat upon them, and judgment was given them; and the souls of those beheaded because of the testimony of Jesus and because of the word of God, and those who did not worship the beast nor its image and did not receive the mark upon their forehead and upon their hand; and they lived and reigned with Christ for the thousand years.

5 But the rest of the dead did not live again until the thousand years should be completed. This is the first resurrection.

6 Blessed and holy is the one having part in the first resurrection; over these the second death has no authority, but they will be priests of God and of Christ, and will reign with him for a thousand years.

7 And when the thousand years should be completed, Satan will be loosed from his prison,

8 and will go out to deceive the nations in the four corners of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them to war, whose number is as the sand of the sea.

9 And they went up upon the breadth of the earth and encircled the camp of the saints and the beloved city, and fire came down from God out of heaven and devoured them.

10 And the devil deceiving them was cast into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet are, and they will be tormented day and night forever and ever.

11 And I saw a great white throne and the one sitting upon it, from whose face earth and heaven fled, and a place was not found for them.

12 And I saw the dead, small and great, standing before God, and books were opened, and another book was opened, which is of life; and the dead were judged from the things written in the books according to their works.

13 And the sea gave the dead in it, and death and Hades gave the dead in them, and they were judged, each according to their works.

14 And death and Hades were cast into the lake of fire. This is the second death.

15 And if anyone was not found written in the book of life, he was cast into the lake of fire.

Chapter 21

1 And I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth passed away, and the sea is no more.

2 And I, John, saw the holy city, new Jerusalem, coming down from God out of heaven, prepared as a bride adorned for her husband.

3 And I heard a great voice from heaven saying: Behold, the tent of God with men, and he will dwell in a tent with them, and they will be his peoples, and God himself will be with them, their God.

4 And God will wipe away every tear from their eyes, and death will be no more, nor mourning nor cry nor pain will be anymore, because the first things departed.

5 And the one sitting upon the throne said: Behold, I make all things new. And he says to me: Write, because these words are true and faithful.

6 And he said to me: It has happened. I am the Alpha and the Omega, the beginning and the end. I will give to the one thirsting from the spring of the water of life freely.

7 The one overcoming will inherit all things, and I will be God to him, and he will be the son to me.

8 But to the cowardly and unbelieving and abominable and murderers and fornicators and sorcerers and idolaters and all the false ones, their part in the lake burning with fire and sulfur, which is second death.

9 And one of the seven angels having the seven bowls full of the seven last plagues came to me and spoke with me, saying: Come, I will show you the bride, the wife of the lamb.

10 And he carried me away in the Spirit upon a great and high mountain, and showed me the great city, the holy Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God,

11 having the glory of God, and its luminary like a most precious stone, as a jasper stone shining like crystal,

12 and having a great and high wall, having twelve gates, and upon the gates twelve angels, and names inscribed, which are of the twelve tribes of the sons of Israel.

13 From the east three gates, from the north three gates, from the south three gates, from the west three gates.

14 And the wall of the city having twelve foundations, and in them names of the twelve apostles of the lamb.

15 And the one speaking with me had a golden reed, so that he might measure the city and its gates and its wall.

16 And the city lies foursquare, and its length is as much as also the breadth; and he measured the city with the reed to twelve thousand stadia. Its length and breadth and height are equal.

17 And he measured its wall, a hundred forty-four cubits, a man's measure, which is an angel's.

18 And the building of its wall was jasper, and the city pure gold, like pure glass.

19 And the foundations of the wall of the city adorned with every precious stone: the first foundation jasper, the second sapphire, the third chalcedony, the fourth emerald,

20 the fifth sardonyx, the sixth sardius, the seventh chrysolite, the eighth beryl, the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprase, the eleventh hyacinth, the twelfth amethyst.

21 And the twelve gates twelve pearls; each one of the gates was from one pearl, and the street of the city pure gold, as transparent glass.

22 And I did not see a temple in it, for the Lord God Almighty is its temple, and the lamb.

23 And the city has no need of the sun nor of the moon to shine in it, for the glory of God illuminated it, and its lamp the lamb.

24 And the nations of those being saved will walk in its light, and the kings of the earth bring their glory and honor into it.

25 And its gates will certainly not be shut by day, for night will not be there.

26 And they will bring the glory and the honor of the nations into it.

27 And anything defiling and doing abomination and falsehood will certainly not enter into it, except those written in the book of life of the lamb.

Chapter 22

1 And he showed me a pure river of water of life, splendid as crystal, going out from the throne of God and of the lamb.

2 In the midst of its street, and on this side and that side of the river, a tree of life producing twelve fruits, giving its fruit each month, and the leaves of the tree for healing of the nations.

3 And every curse will be no more, and the throne of God and of the lamb will be in it, and his slaves will serve him,

4 and they will see his face, and his name upon their foreheads.

5 And night will not be there, and they have no need of a lamp and light of sun, because the Lord God illuminates them, and they will reign forever and ever.

6 And he said to me: These words are faithful and true; and the Lord God of the holy prophets sent his angel to show his slaves what must happen soon.

7 Behold, I come quickly. Blessed is the one keeping the words of the prophecy of this book.

8 And I, John, the one seeing these things and hearing; and when I heard and saw, I fell to worship before the feet of the angel showing me these things.

9 And he says to me: See that you do not; for I am your fellow slave and of your brothers the prophets and of those keeping the words of this book. Worship God.

10 And he says to me: Do not seal the words of the prophecy of this book, because the time is near.

11 The one doing injustice, let him do injustice still; and the one being filthy, let him be filthy still; and the righteous one, let him be justified still; and the holy one, let him be sanctified still.

12 And behold, I come quickly, and my reward with me, to give back to each as his work will be.

13 I am the Alpha and the Omega, beginning and end, the first and the last.

14 Blessed are those doing his commandments, so that their authority will be over the tree of life, and they may enter through the gates into the city.

15 But outside are the dogs and the sorcerers and the fornicators and the murderers and the idolaters and everyone loving and doing falsehood.

16 I, Jesus, sent my angel to testify these things to you concerning the churches. I am the root and the offspring of David, the splendid and morning star.

17 And the Spirit and the bride say: Come. And the one hearing, let him say: Come. And the one thirsting, let him come; and the one wishing, let him take water of life freely.

18 For I testify together to everyone hearing the words of the prophecy of this book: If anyone adds to these things, God will add upon him the plagues written in this book.

19 And if anyone takes away from the words of the book of this prophecy, God will take away his part from the book of life and from the holy city and the things written in this book.

20 The one testifying these things says: Yes, I come quickly. Amen. Yes, come, Lord Jesus.

21 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with all of you. Amen.